Liturgical and Ecclesiastical Life in Reformation Germany

An Examination of the German Church Orders from 1521–1620

English-only edition

Contents

- Introduction
  - The source: Sehling's edition
  - How the book is arranged
  - The repository and its methods
    - The digital corpus
    - The corpus database (`eko.db`)
    - How the chapters were made
    - The hymn database (`hymns.db`)
    - The general-prayer workbook and database (`general_prayers.db`)
      - What counts as the general prayer
      - Representative texts
      - What the comparison shows
- Conventions
  - Citations and references
  - Quotations
  - Translations
  - Traditions and the Interim
  - Abbreviations
  - The inventory tables of Chapter 1
- Chapter 1. The Church Orders: An Inventory by Tradition
  - 1.1 Summary of findings
  - 1.2 Scope, sources and cautions
    - 1.2.1 What Sehling counted as a church order
    - 1.2.2 What he left out: half measures and the Interim
    - 1.2.3 How the list was made
    - 1.2.4 Kinds
    - 1.2.5 Cautions
  - 1.3 The traditions
    - 1.3.1 Lutheran (L)
    - 1.3.2 Reformed (R)
    - 1.3.3 Moderate Reformed (MR) and Philippist (PH)
    - 1.3.4 Anglican (A)
    - 1.3.5 Hussite: the Bohemian Brethren (H), and the Sandomierz consensus (C)
    - 1.3.6 Others
  - 1.4 The Interim orders
  - 1.5 The territories at a glance
  - 1.6 Volume 1: Saxony and Thuringia I: Luther; Ernestine and Albertine Saxony
    - 1.6.1 Martin Luther's orders
    - 1.6.2 Saxony: editor's introductions
    - 1.6.3 Ernestine Saxony
    - 1.6.4 Albertine Saxony
    - 1.6.5 Freiberg and Wolkenstein (Duke Henry)
    - 1.6.6 Towns of Ernestine and Albertine Saxony
  - 1.7 Volume 2: Saxony and Thuringia II: bishoprics, counties, Henneberg, Magdeburg, Anhalt
    - 1.7.1 Bishoprics of Merseburg, Meissen, Naumburg-Zeitz and Wurzen

        - 1.7.2 Amt Stolpen and Bischofswerda
        - 1.7.3 Lordship and town of Plauen
        - 1.7.4 Lordship of Ronneburg
        - 1.7.5 Schwarzburg
        - 1.7.6 Reuss
        - 1.7.7 Schönburg
        - 1.7.8 Harz counties (Mansfeld, Stolberg, Hohenstein, Regenstein, Quedlinburg)
        - 1.7.9 County of Henneberg
        - 1.7.10 Mainz possessions (Eichsfeld, Erfurt, Querfurt)
        - 1.7.11 Imperial cities of Mühlhausen and Nordhausen
        - 1.7.12 Archbishopric of Magdeburg and Bishopric of Halberstadt
        - 1.7.13 Principality of Anhalt
        - 1.7.14 Naumburg cathedral (supplement)
    - 1.8 Volume 3: Brandenburg, Lusatia, Silesia
        - 1.8.1 Electorate of Brandenburg
        - 1.8.2 Lordships of Beeskow and Storkow
        - 1.8.3 Lands of the von der Schulenburg family
        - 1.8.4 Towns of the Mark Brandenburg
        - 1.8.5 Upper and Lower Lusatia
        - 1.8.6 Silesia
    - 1.9 Volume 4: Prussia, Poland, Pomerania
        - 1.9.1 Duchy of Prussia
        - 1.9.2 Royal Prussia: Danzig, Elbing, Thorn and their lands
        - 1.9.3 Greater Poland (Posen): synods, the Bohemian Brethren and the towns
        - 1.9.4 Duchy of Pomerania
    - 1.10 Volume 5: Livonia, Estonia, Courland, Mecklenburg, Lübeck, Lauenburg, Hamburg
        - 1.10.1 Livonia
        - 1.10.2 Estonia (Reval)
        - 1.10.3 Courland
        - 1.10.4 Mecklenburg
        - 1.10.5 Lübeck with Bergedorf
        - 1.10.6 Lauenburg and the Land Hadeln
        - 1.10.7 Hamburg
    - 1.11 Volume 6/1: Lower Saxony I/1: Wolfenbüttel, Braunschweig, Lüneburg
        - 1.11.1 Principality of Wolfenbüttel
        - 1.11.2 Town of Braunschweig
        - 1.11.3 Principality of Lüneburg
        - 1.11.4 Town of Lüneburg
    - 1.12 Volume 6/2: Lower Saxony I/2: Calenberg-Göttingen, Grubenhagen, Hoya-Diepholz
        - 1.12.1 Principality of Calenberg-Göttingen
        - 1.12.2 Town of Göttingen
        - 1.12.3 Town of Northeim
        - 1.12.4 Town of Hannover
        - 1.12.5 Principality of Grubenhagen
        - 1.12.6 Town of Einbeck
        - 1.12.7 Counties of Hoya and Diepholz
    - 1.13 Volume 7/1: Lower Saxony II/1: Bremen (archbishopric), Verden, Osnabrück, East Frisia
        - 1.13.1 Archbishopric of Bremen
        - 1.13.2 Town of Stade
        - 1.13.3 Town of Buxtehude
        - 1.13.4 Bishopric of Verden
        - 1.13.5 Bishopric of Osnabrück
        - 1.13.6 Town of Osnabrück
        - 1.13.7 East Frisia: comital orders

        - 1.13.8 East Frisia: treaties
        - 1.13.9 East Frisia: Reformed orders of limited range (Norden, Emden, Leer, Lütetsburg; London)
        - 1.13.10 East Frisia and Harlingerland: Lutheran orders of limited range
    - 1.14 Volume 7/2.1: Lower Saxony II/2.1: Hildesheim, Oldenburg, Jever
        - 1.14.1 Bishopric of Hildesheim (Steuerwald and Peine)
        - 1.14.2 Town of Hildesheim
        - 1.14.3 County of Oldenburg
        - 1.14.4 Lordship of Jever
    - 1.15 Volume 7/2.2: Lower Saxony II/2.2: Schaumburg, Goslar, Bremen (city)
        - 1.15.1 County of Schaumburg
        - 1.15.2 Imperial city of Goslar
        - 1.15.3 City of Bremen
    - 1.16 Volume 8: Hesse I
        - 1.16.1 Landgraviate of Hesse under Philip (to 1567)
        - 1.16.2 The Hessian landgraviates: joint synods and orders (1567-1582)
    - 1.17 Volume 9: Hesse II: divided Hesse, Waldeck, Solms, Erbach, Frankfurt, Wetterau cities
        - 1.17.1 Divided Hesse (1582-1618)
        - 1.17.2 County of Waldeck
        - 1.17.3 County of Solms
        - 1.17.4 County of Erbach
        - 1.17.5 County of Stolberg-Königstein
        - 1.17.6 Imperial city of Frankfurt
        - 1.17.7 Imperial castle and city of Friedberg
        - 1.17.8 Imperial city of Gelnhausen
        - 1.17.9 Imperial city of Wetzlar
    - 1.18 Volume 10: Hesse III: Nassau, Hanau-Münzenberg, Ysenburg
        - 1.18.1 Nassau-Dillenburg
        - 1.18.2 Nassau-Weilburg and Nassau-Saarbrücken
        - 1.18.3 Nassau-Wiesbaden and Nassau-Idstein
        - 1.18.4 County of Hanau-Münzenberg
        - 1.18.5 County of Ysenburg
    - 1.19 Volume 11: Bavaria I: Franconia (Nuremberg, Ansbach-Kulmbach, imperial cities)
        - 1.19.1 Imperial city of Nuremberg (to 1528)
        - 1.19.2 Brandenburg-Ansbach-Kulmbach (to 1528)
        - 1.19.3 Brandenburg and Nuremberg together (1528-1533)
        - 1.19.4 Brandenburg-Ansbach-Kulmbach (from 1528/1533)
        - 1.19.5 Imperial city of Nuremberg (from 1533)
        - 1.19.6 Imperial city of Rothenburg ob der Tauber
        - 1.19.7 Imperial city of Schweinfurt with Gochsheim and Sennfeld
        - 1.19.8 Imperial city of Weißenburg (Franconia)
        - 1.19.9 Imperial city of Windsheim
        - 1.19.10 County of Castell
        - 1.19.11 County of Rieneck
        - 1.19.12 County of Wertheim
        - 1.19.13 Lordship of Thüngen
    - 1.20 Volume 12: Bavaria II: Swabia (Augsburg and the Swabian imperial cities)
        - 1.20.1 Imperial city of Augsburg
        - 1.20.2 Imperial city of Dinkelsbühl
        - 1.20.3 Imperial city of Donauwörth
        - 1.20.4 Imperial city of Kempten
        - 1.20.5 Imperial city of Lindau
        - 1.20.6 Imperial city of Memmingen
        - 1.20.7 Imperial city of Nördlingen
        - 1.20.8 County of Oettingen-Oettingen

- 1.21 Volume 13: Bavaria III: Altbayern (Pfalz-Neuburg, Upper Palatinate, Regensburg)
  - 1.21.1 Duchy of Pfalz-Neuburg
  - 1.21.2 Upper Palatinate (Electoral Palatinate)
  - 1.21.3 Imperial city of Regensburg
  - 1.21.4 County of Ortenburg
  - 1.21.5 Lordship of Rothenberg
  - 1.21.6 Lordship of Wolfstein
- 1.22 Volume 14: Electoral Palatinate (Kurpfalz)
  - 1.22.1 Electoral Palatinate (Kurpfalz)
- 1.23 Volume 15: Württemberg I: County of Hohenlohe
  - 1.23.1 County of Hohenlohe
- 1.24 Volume 16: Baden-Württemberg II: Württemberg, Baden, Limpurg
  - 1.24.1 Duchy of Württemberg (with Mömpelgard and Horburg)
  - 1.24.2 Margraviate of Baden
  - 1.24.3 County of Limpurg
  - 1.24.4 Lordship of Kinzigtal (Fürstenberg)
  - 1.24.5 Lordship of Neckarbischofsheim
- 1.25 Volume 17/1: Baden-Württemberg III/1: Hall, Heilbronn, Konstanz, Isny, Gengenbach
  - 1.25.1 Imperial city of Schwäbisch Hall
  - 1.25.2 Imperial city of Heilbronn
  - 1.25.3 Imperial city of Konstanz
  - 1.25.4 Imperial city of Isny
  - 1.25.5 Imperial city of Gengenbach
  - 1.25.6 Württemberg: school orders of the Great Church Order of 1559 (supplement to vol. 16)
- 1.26 Volume 17/2: Baden-Württemberg III/2: Reutlingen, Ulm, Esslingen and other cities
  - 1.26.1 Imperial city of Reutlingen
  - 1.26.2 Imperial city of Ulm
  - 1.26.3 Imperial city of Esslingen
  - 1.26.4 Imperial city of Giengen an der Brenz
  - 1.26.5 Imperial city of Biberach an der Riß
  - 1.26.6 Imperial city of Ravensburg
  - 1.26.7 Imperial city of Wimpfen
  - 1.26.8 Imperial city of Leutkirch
  - 1.26.9 Imperial city of Bopfingen
  - 1.26.10 Imperial city of Aalen
- 1.27 Volume 18: Rhineland-Palatinate I: Pfalz-Zweibrücken, Veldenz, Sponheim
  - 1.27.1 Duchy of Pfalz-Zweibrücken
  - 1.27.2 County of Pfalz-Veldenz with Lützelstein and Guttenberg
  - 1.27.3 Counties of Sponheim
  - 1.27.4 Lordship of Sickingen
  - 1.27.5 County of Manderscheid-Schleiden
- 1.28 Volume 19/1: Rhineland-Palatinate II/1: Landau, Speyer, Worms, Leiningen, Sayn, Wied
  - 1.28.1 Imperial city of Landau
  - 1.28.2 Imperial city of Speyer
  - 1.28.3 Imperial city of Worms
  - 1.28.4 Counties of Leiningen
  - 1.28.5 County of Sayn
  - 1.28.6 County of Wied
- 1.29 Volume 19/2: Rhineland-Palatinate II/2: Wild- and Rhinegraviate, Simmern; supplements
  - 1.29.1 Wild- and Rhinegraviate
  - 1.29.2 Principality of Pfalz-Simmern
  - 1.29.3 County of Pfalz-Veldenz (supplement to vol. 18)
  - 1.29.4 Electoral Palatinate (supplement to vol. 14)
- 1.30 Volume 20/1: Alsace I: Strasbourg

        - 1.30.1 Imperial city of Strasbourg
    - 1.31 Volume 20/2: Alsace II: territories and imperial cities
        - 1.31.1 County of Hanau-Lichtenberg
        - 1.31.2 Lordship of Fleckenstein
        - 1.31.3 Lordship of Rappoltstein
        - 1.31.4 Imperial city of Mülhausen (Mulhouse)
        - 1.31.5 Imperial city of Weißenburg (Alsace)
        - 1.31.6 Münster im Gregoriental
        - 1.31.7 Imperial city of Hagenau
        - 1.31.8 Imperial city of Colmar
    - 1.32 Volume 21: North Rhine-Westphalia I: Jülich-Cleves-Berg, Lippe and others
        - 1.32.1 United Duchies of Jülich-Cleves-Berg
        - 1.32.2 Bishopric and town of Minden
        - 1.32.3 Imperial abbey and town of Herford
        - 1.32.4 Imperial city of Dortmund
        - 1.32.5 Imperial abbey of Corvey (Höxter)
        - 1.32.6 County of Lippe
        - 1.32.7 Imperial abbey and town of Essen
    - 1.33 Volume 22: North Rhine-Westphalia II: Cologne, Wittgenstein, Bentheim, Soest and others
        - 1.33.1 Archbishopric of Cologne
        - 1.33.2 County of Wittgenstein
        - 1.33.3 County of Moers
        - 1.33.4 County of Bentheim-Tecklenburg
        - 1.33.5 County of Rietberg
        - 1.33.6 City of Münster
        - 1.33.7 City of Soest
        - 1.33.8 Town of Neuenrade
        - 1.33.9 County of Lippe (supplement)
    - 1.34 Volume 23: Schleswig-Holstein and Dithmarschen
        - 1.34.1 Duchies of Schleswig and Holstein
        - 1.34.2 Land of Dithmarschen
    - 1.35 Volume 24: Transylvania
        - 1.35.1 Principality of Transylvania: diets
        - 1.35.2 Transylvanian Saxons
- Chapter 2. The Order of the Mass
    - 2.1 Summary of findings
    - 2.2 Scope, sources and method
        - 2.2.1 Sources and searches
        - 2.2.2 What was not found
    - 2.3 The baselines: the Roman ordo and Luther's two Masses
        - 2.3.1 The Roman ordo in outline
        - 2.3.2 *Formula missae*, 1523: the Latin Mass purged
        - 2.3.3 *Deutsche Messe*, 1526: the German Mass for the people
        - 2.3.4 The three side by side
    - 2.4 The families of evangelical ordo
        - 2.4.1 The Saxon Mass: Latin and German together
        - 2.4.2 Bugenhagen's northern Mass
        - 2.4.3 The Franconian Mass: Nürnberg and Brandenburg-Ansbach
        - 2.4.4 The Prussian Mass of 1525: the Words of Institution in the Preface
        - 2.4.5 The Mass that kept the Latin frame
        - 2.4.6 The Upper German preaching service with communion
        - 2.4.7 The Reformed Supper
        - 2.4.8 The early German Masses
    - 2.5 The ordos compared

    - 2.6 The Kyrie
        - 2.6.1 Three, four or nine
        - 2.6.2 Which Kyrie: the seasonal chants
        - 2.6.3 Which language
    - 2.7 The Gloria
        - 2.7.1 The Gloria belongs to the festal Kyrie
        - 2.7.2 Intonation, *Et in terra*, and the divided Gloria
        - 2.7.3 The Gloria and the Kyrie as one piece
    - 2.8 Salutation, collect and Pax
    - 2.9 The Creed
        - 2.9.1 Intoned by the priest, sung by the choir, then by the people
        - 2.9.2 Nicene, Apostles' or Athanasian
        - 2.9.3 Where the creed fell
        - 2.9.4 Which creed, order by order
    - 2.10 The Preface and the Sanctus
        - 2.10.1 The Preface: required, optional, festal or gone
        - 2.10.2 Where the Sanctus fell
        - 2.10.3 With or without the Benedictus
    - 2.11 The Lord's Prayer and the Words of Institution
    - 2.12 The Agnus Dei
        - 2.12.1 How many times
        - 2.12.2 Where it fell
    - 2.13 The dismissal and the blessing
        - 2.13.1 *Ite missa est*, *Benedicamus*, or neither
        - 2.13.2 The blessing: Aaronic, Trinitarian, or both
    - 2.14 When nobody communicated
    - 2.15 Ceremonial: gestures, postures and places
        - 2.15.1 What the orders say, and what they do not
        - 2.15.2 The sign of the cross
        - 2.15.3 Kneeling, not genuflecting
        - 2.15.4 Bowing
        - 2.15.5 Hats and heads
        - 2.15.6 Hands
        - 2.15.7 Turning: toward the altar, toward the people
        - 2.15.8 Places at the altar
        - 2.15.9 The Peace, the kiss and incense
        - 2.15.10 Summary
    - 2.16 Concordance of the orders quoted
- Chapter 3. Mass Preliminaries
    - 3.1 Summary of findings
    - 3.2 Scope, sources and method
    - 3.3 Opening versicles and preliminaries
        - 3.3.1 What the Roman Mass had, and what became of it
        - 3.3.2 Family A: the priest's own *Confiteor* at the altar
        - 3.3.3 Family B: Bugenhagen's kneeling prayer with the sexton
        - 3.3.4 Family C: Döber and the Mecklenburg public confession
        - 3.3.5 Family D: the *Offene Schuld* moved into the Mass
        - 3.3.6 Family E: the Upper German and Reformed opening
        - 3.3.7 Family F: a hymn, a psalm or *Veni Sancte Spiritus* at the beginning
        - 3.3.8 Family G: Müntzer's Allstedt Mass; *Iudica me* and *Aufer a nobis* elsewhere
    - 3.4 Confession and absolution: what the orders did with the *Confiteor*
        - 3.4.1 Where it falls
        - 3.4.2 Who says it, and does the chancel party pray it together?
        - 3.4.3 Old texts or new?

        - 3.4.4 Optative, declaratory or indicative?
        - 3.4.5 The public confession and the modern Common Service
        - 3.4.6 General confession against private confession
    - 3.5 The exhortation to the communicants: the families collated
        - 3.5.1 Where it falls, and what it is for
        - 3.5.2 The families and their witnesses
        - 3.5.3 The Luther family: Wittenberg, *Deutsche Messe*, 1526
        - 3.5.4 The Osiander family: Nürnberg, 1524
        - 3.5.5 The Brandenburg-Nürnberg family, 1533
        - 3.5.6 The Württemberg family, 1536 and 1553
        - 3.5.7 The Bugenhagen family: Brunswick, 1528
        - 3.5.8 The Naumburg family, 1537
        - 3.5.9 The Mecklenburg family, 1552
        - 3.5.10 The Palatinate family, 1563
        - 3.5.11 The Pfalz-Veldenz family, 1574
        - 3.5.12 The Basel family: Memmingen 1528 and Neckarbischofsheim 1560
        - 3.5.13 The Strasbourg family, 1525
        - 3.5.14 Exhortations outside the families
            - 3.5.14.1 Kantz 1522 and the Bremen Mass 1525
            - 3.5.14.2 Augsburg, St. Anna, 1530
            - 3.5.14.3 Buxtehude, *Agende*, 1565
            - 3.5.14.4 Micron, London 1554, German 1565
            - 3.5.14.5 Three short notes
    - 3.6 Before and after the service
        - 3.6.1 Vesting prayers
        - 3.6.2 The psalms and the *Ne reminiscaris*
        - 3.6.3 After the Mass
        - 3.6.4 Prayers before and after the sermon
        - 3.6.5 On entering and leaving church; the communicants' own prayers
    - 3.7 Table by order
    - 3.8 Concordance of the orders quoted
- Chapter 4. The Propers of the Mass
    - 4.1 Summary of findings
    - 4.2 Scope, sources and cautions
    - 4.3 Three ways of handling the propers
        - 4.3.1 Latin propers, sung by the school (the *Formula missae* line)
        - 4.3.2 German prose propers, sung to the old tones
        - 4.3.3 Hymns in place of the propers (the *Deutsche Messe* line)
    - 4.4 The introit
        - 4.4.1 Luther's rule: the Sunday and festal introits, if from Scripture
        - 4.4.2 Who sang it: the school, in Latin, with a German psalm for the villages
        - 4.4.3 The Trinity or Holy Ghost introit as a fallback
        - 4.4.4 German introits
        - 4.4.5 Organ, polyphony and alternation
    - 4.5 The lessons: prophecy, epistle and gospel
        - 4.5.1 The Old Testament "prophecy"
        - 4.5.2 The epistle and gospel: kept, and read toward the people
        - 4.5.3 Sung or read, Latin or German
    - 4.6 Gradual, alleluia and tract
        - 4.6.1 Luther: two verses, and the alleluia always
        - 4.6.2 Kept where pure, by the school, or exchanged for a German psalm
        - 4.6.3 German graduals
        - 4.6.4 The sequence
    - 4.7 The offertory

        - 4.7.1 Rejected with the offertory prayers
        - 4.7.2 Kept as a sung text from Scripture
        - 4.7.3 A German psalm, or the Creed, in its place
    - 4.8 The Proper Preface
        - 4.8.1 Kept, shortened or dropped
        - 4.8.2 Which days: the temporal cycle
        - 4.8.3 Saints' days: Michaelmas, the Virgin and the Apostles
        - 4.8.4 Who sang it, in what language, to which tune
    - 4.9 The communion chant (*communio*)
        - 4.9.1 Optional, and soon replaced
        - 4.9.2 Polyphonic communions and festal motets
    - 4.10 The music: old chant, cut chant, new tones, polyphony and organ
        - 4.10.1 The old melodies kept
        - 4.10.2 The old melodies cut
        - 4.10.3 New tones for German texts
        - 4.10.4 Polyphony
        - 4.10.5 The organ
    - 4.11 Table by order
    - 4.12 Concordance of the orders quoted
    - Appendix 4.A The Proper Prefaces: texts and translations
        - 4.A.1 The dialogue and the common Preface (*Quotidiana*, *Praefatio communis*)
        - 4.A.2 Christmas (*Quia per incarnati Verbi mysterium*)
        - 4.A.3 Epiphany (*Quia cum Unigenitus tuus*)
        - 4.A.4 Lent (*Qui corporali ieiunio*)
        - 4.A.5 Passiontide and the Holy Cross (*Qui salutem humani generis in ligno crucis*)
        - 4.A.6 Easter (*Te quidem, Domine, omni tempore*)
        - 4.A.7 Ascension (*Qui post resurrectionem suam*)
        - 4.A.8 Pentecost (*Qui ascendens super omnes caelos*)
        - 4.A.9 Trinity (*Qui cum unigenito Filio tuo*)
        - 4.A.10 The Blessed Virgin (*Et te in … beatae Mariae*), and Müntzer's Advent rewording
        - 4.A.11 The Apostles (*Et te, Domine, suppliciter exorare*)
        - 4.A.12 Passiontide and Maundy Thursday: Grubenhagen's Isaiah 53 Preface (new German text)
        - 4.A.13 Michaelmas: Lippe's German Preface for the villages (new German text)
        - 4.A.14 Christmas in Kurland: the Easter Preface with the Nativity prefixed (new German text)
        - 4.A.15 Pentecost in Kurland: the Easter Preface with the Ascension and Pentecost added (new German text)
        - 4.A.16 Summary: which Prefaces each order has
- Chapter 5. Collect, Secret and Postcommunion
    - 5.1 Summary of findings
    - 5.2 Scope, sources and cautions
    - 5.3 The medieval system and Luther's rulings
        - 5.3.1 What the reformers inherited
        - 5.3.2 Luther's *Formula missae*, 1523: one collect, no secret, a new postcommunion
        - 5.3.3 Luther's *Deutsche Messe*, 1526: one collect and a fixed thanksgiving
    - 5.4 The collect
        - 5.4.1 One collect, or two
        - 5.4.2 The collect of the day kept, in German
        - 5.4.3 The collects purged
        - 5.4.4 New collects added: the gospel collects
        - 5.4.5 Language, voice and form
    - 5.5 The secret
        - 5.5.1 Abolished with the offertory
        - 5.5.2 What took the secret's place
    - 5.6 The postcommunion
        - 5.6.1 Luther's 1523 substitutes: *Quod ore sumpsimus* and *Corpus tuum*

        - 5.6.2 Proper postcommunions kept
        - 5.6.3 Luther's thanksgiving becomes the ordinary postcommunion
        - 5.6.4 The alternatives
        - 5.6.5 When there was no communion
        - 5.6.6 The prayer over the people (*oratio super populum*)
    - 5.7 Kept, stripped, added, altered
    - 5.8 Table by order
    - 5.9 Concordance of the orders quoted
    - Appendix 5.A The postcommunion texts and their sources
- Chapter 6. The General Prayer of the Church: Texts by Family
    - 6.1 The general prayer in the Sunday service
        - 6.1.1 What it is
        - 6.1.2 Where it stands in the service
        - 6.1.3 Its forms
        - 6.1.4 The sequence of intentions
    - 6.2 How the texts are given here
    - 6.3 The families at a glance
    - 6.4 Family A: Brenz bidding prayer
        - A.1 Exhortation / preface
        - A.2 The Church
        - A.3 Civil authority
        - A.4 The afflicted
        - A.5 Peace
        - A.6 Enemies
        - A.7 Women with child
        - A.8 Fruits of the earth
        - A.9 Lord's Prayer
        - A.10 Lord's Prayer
        - A.11 Creed
        - A.12 Ten Commandments
        - A.13 Special intercessions
        - A.14 Communicants
        - A.15 Blessing
    - 6.5 Family B1: Württemberg long form
        - B1.1 Exhortation / preface
        - B1.2 Confession of sins
        - B1.3 Confession of sins
        - B1.4 Confession of sins
        - B1.5 The Church
        - B1.6 Civil authority
        - B1.7 The afflicted
        - B1.8 The erring & unbelievers
        - B1.9 Peace
        - B1.10 Enemies
        - B1.11 Women with child
        - B1.12 Fruits of the earth
        - B1.13 Lord's Prayer
    - 6.6 Family B2: Württemberg short form
        - B2.1 Exhortation / preface
        - B2.2 Thanksgiving
        - B2.3 Confession of sins
        - B2.4 Confession of sins
        - B2.5 The Church
        - B2.6 Civil authority

        - B2.7 Enemies
        - B2.8 The erring & unbelievers
        - B2.9 The afflicted
        - B2.10 Fruits of the earth
        - B2.11 Conclusion
        - B2.12 Communicants
        - B2.13 Lord's Prayer
        - B2.14 Lord's Prayer
        - B2.15 Special intercessions
    - 6.7 Family C: Bidding exhortation (Strasbourg type)
        - C.1 Exhortation / preface
        - C.2 The Word & its fruit
        - C.3 Civil authority
        - C.4 All estates / households
        - C.5 Fruits of the earth
        - C.6 The afflicted
        - C.7 Special intercessions
        - C.8 Lord's Prayer
    - 6.8 Family D: Nürnberg-type Vermahnung zum Gebet
        - D.1 Exhortation / preface
        - D.2 Thanksgiving
        - D.3 The Word & its fruit
        - D.4 The Church
        - D.5 Peace
        - D.6 Civil authority
        - D.7 All estates / households
        - D.8 The persecuted
        - D.9 The afflicted
        - D.10 The erring & unbelievers
        - D.11 Women with child
        - D.12 Lord's Prayer
        - D.13 Special intercessions
        - D.14 Creed
        - D.15 Blessing
    - 6.9 Family E: Saxon Gemein Gebet (Melanchthon/Pfeffinger)
        - E.1 Repentance & forgiveness
        - E.2 The Church
        - E.3 Civil authority
        - E.4 Peace
        - E.5 Civil authority
        - E.6 The afflicted
    - 6.10 Family F: Upper German pulpit intercession (Strasbourg/Zürich)
        - F.1 Exhortation / preface
        - F.2 All men
        - F.3 Civil authority
        - F.4 Ministers of the Word
        - F.5 All estates / households
        - F.6 Special intercessions
        - F.7 Women with child
        - F.8 Schools & youth
        - F.9 All estates / households
        - F.10 The afflicted
        - F.11 Special intercessions
        - F.12 The persecuted

        - F.13 The erring & unbelievers
        - F.14 Against the Turk
        - F.15 Against the Turk
        - F.16 Lord's Prayer
    - 6.11 Family G: Hessian Vermanung zum Gebet
        - G.1 Exhortation / preface
        - G.2 Ministers of the Word
        - G.3 Civil authority
        - G.4 The erring & unbelievers
        - G.5 Enemies
        - G.6 The afflicted
        - G.7 Deliverance from calamities
        - G.8 Conclusion
        - G.9 Special intercessions
    - 6.12 Family H: Bugenhagen pulpit exhortation
        - H.1 Creed
        - H.2 Confession of sins
        - H.3 The Word & its fruit
        - H.4 Civil authority
        - H.5 The present congregation
        - H.6 Ministers of the Word
        - H.7 Peace
        - H.8 Lord's Prayer
        - H.9 Special intercessions
    - 6.13 Family I: Huberinus Vorbitt (Lord’s-Prayer order)
        - I.1 Exhortation / preface
        - I.2 Civil authority
        - I.3 The persecuted
        - I.4 Peace
        - I.5 Repentance & forgiveness
        - I.6 Women with child
        - I.7 Special intercessions
        - I.8 Lord's Prayer
        - I.9 Conclusion
    - 6.14 Family J: Lower Saxon notel (Lüneburg/Wolfenbüttel)
        - J.1 The Word & its fruit
        - J.2 Civil authority
        - J.3 Thanksgiving
        - J.4 Civil authority
        - J.5 The afflicted
        - J.6 Deliverance from calamities
        - J.7 Lord's Prayer
        - J.8 Special intercessions
    - 6.15 Family K: Three collects from the pulpit
        - K.1 Exhortation / preface
        - K.2 Thanksgiving
        - K.3 The Church
        - K.4 Civil authority
        - K.5 Special intercessions
    - 6.16 Family L: Intercessions under the Sanctus (Brandenburg 1540)
        - L.1 Civil authority
        - L.2 Ministers of the Word
        - L.3 Peace
        - L.4 Repentance & forgiveness

        - L.5 Lord's Prayer
    - 6.17 Family M: Pulpit biddings in the Prone pattern
        - M.1 Civil authority
        - M.2 Ministers of the Word
        - M.3 Enemies
        - M.4 Ten Commandments
    - 6.18 Family R1: Heidelberg 1563 prayer
        - R1.1 Confession of sins
        - R1.2 Confession of sins
        - R1.3 Thanksgiving
        - R1.4 The Word & its fruit
        - R1.5 Civil authority
        - R1.6 Fruits of the earth
        - R1.7 All men
        - R1.8 The persecuted
        - R1.9 The afflicted
        - R1.10 Lord's Prayer
    - 6.19 Family R2: Heidelberg Lord’s-Prayer paraphrase
        - R2.1 Exhortation / preface
        - R2.2 The Word & its fruit
        - R2.3 The Church
        - R2.4 All estates / households
        - R2.5 Fruits of the earth
        - R2.6 Repentance & forgiveness
        - R2.7 The present congregation
        - R2.8 Conclusion
        - R2.9 Creed
    - 6.20 Family R3: Calvin’s “grande prière” (Strasbourg/Geneva)
        - R3.1 Special intercessions
        - R3.2 Exhortation / preface
        - R3.3 Civil authority
        - R3.4 Ministers of the Word
        - R3.5 All men
        - R3.6 The afflicted
        - R3.7 The persecuted
        - R3.8 The present congregation
        - R3.9 Lord's Prayer
        - R3.10 Creed
    - 6.21 Family R4: à Lasco/Micron (London stranger church)
        - R4.1 Thanksgiving
        - R4.2 The Church
        - R4.3 Civil authority
        - R4.4 The present congregation
        - R4.5 The present congregation
        - R4.6 The erring & unbelievers
        - R4.7 The persecuted
        - R4.8 The afflicted
        - R4.9 Lord's Prayer
        - R4.10 Special intercessions
- Chapter 7. The Roman Canon in German Evangelical Masses (1522–1544)
    - 7.1 Summary of findings
        - 7.1.1 Findings
        - 7.1.2 Concordance tables
        - 7.1.3 Method, and orders examined but not printed

- 7.2 Nördlingen, Kaspar Kantz, *Von der Evangelischen Mesß*, 1522
  - 7.2.1 Address, absolution and the recast *Orate fratres*
  - 7.2.2 *Veni Sancte Spiritus* and collect (in place of *Veni sanctificator*)
  - 7.2.3 Preface and Sanctus
  - 7.2.4 *Quam oblationem* and *Qui pridie*
  - 7.2.5 Our Father with the conclusion of the embolism; *Agnus Dei*; *Fili Dei vivi*
  - 7.2.6 Communion, with the *custodiat* and *Calicem salutaris*
  - 7.2.7 Thanksgiving: *Nunc dimittis*, *Te Deum*, collects
- 7.3 Wittenberg, Luther, *Formula missae et communionis*, 1523
  - 7.3.1 The rule, and the preparation of bread and wine
  - 7.3.2 Preface, Verba, Sanctus with elevation
  - 7.3.3 Our Father; no embolism, no fraction; the Peace as absolution
  - 7.3.4 Communion: *Agnus Dei*, *Fili Dei vivi*, *custodiat*
  - 7.3.5 Communion chant; *Quod ore sumpsimus* and *Corpus tuum* for the postcommunion;
  - 7.3.6 The *Deutsche Messe* of 1526 (for comparison)
- 7.4 Allstedt, Thomas Müntzer, *Deutsch evangelisch Messe*, 1524, and *Ordnung des teutschen ampts*, 1523/24
  - 7.4.1 Offertory, Preface, Sanctus (Advent)
  - 7.4.2 The Verba, the Our Father, the end of the embolism, the Peace, *Agnus Dei*
  - 7.4.3 The Allstedt *Ordnung* on the Sacrament: Verba, elevation, fraction
  - 7.4.4 Postcommunion and *Benedicamus* (Advent Mass)
- 7.5 Strasbourg, the early German Masses, 1524–1525
  - 7.5.1 Schwarz's Mass, 1524 (form a)
  - 7.5.2 The *Ordnung des Herren Nachtmal*, 1525 (form e): the prayer "in place of the Canon"
  - 7.5.3 *Straßburger kirchen ampt*, 1525 (form f)
- 7.6 Worms, *Deutsche Messe*, 1524
  - 7.6.1 Preparation of the chalice (*Orate fratres*)
  - 7.6.2 Preface and Sanctus
  - 7.6.3 *Te igitur*
  - 7.6.4 *Memento* of the living, with the end of *Communicantes*
  - 7.6.5 *Hanc igitur*
  - 7.6.6 *Quam oblationem*
  - 7.6.7 *Qui pridie, Simili modo, Haec quotiescumque*
  - 7.6.8 *Unde et memores* and *Supra quae*
  - 7.6.9 *Supplices te rogamus*
  - 7.6.10 Our Father, with the conclusion of the embolism
  - 7.6.11 Fraction forbidden; the Peace as absolution
  - 7.6.12 *Agnus Dei* and communion
  - 7.6.13 Postcommunion, *Benedicamus*, blessing, *Nunc dimittis*
- 7.7 Nürnberg, 1524–1525: the parish churches, Volprecht, and the *Form und Ordnung*
  - 7.7.1 The parish churches, 1524 (Latin)
  - 7.7.2 Volprecht, 1524
  - 7.7.3 *Form und Ordnung einer Christlichen Messe*, 1525
- 7.8 Nürnberg, Döber's *Deutsche Messe*, 1525
  - 7.8.1 Preparation of the gifts (after the Gradual)
  - 7.8.2 Preface
  - 7.8.3 The Verba
  - 7.8.4 Sanctus
  - 7.8.5 Our Father and the remnant of the embolism
  - 7.8.6 Salutation and *Agnus Dei*
  - 7.8.7 The exhortation (Osiander)
  - 7.8.8 *Domine Iesu Christe, Fili Dei vivi*, said by the people
  - 7.8.9 Communion
  - 7.8.10 *Nunc dimittis*, postcommunion, dismissal and blessing
  - 7.8.11 Optional intercession in the place of *Te igitur*

- 7.9 Bremen, *Eyne evangelysce Misse*, 1525 (Kantz in Low German)
  - 7.9.1 The meditation during Mass
  - 7.9.2 The Mass: preparation
  - 7.9.3 Preface, Sanctus, *Quam oblationem* and *Qui pridie*
  - 7.9.4 Our Father, *Agnus Dei*, *Fili Dei vivi*, communion, *Nunc dimittis*
- 7.10 Lippe, *Deutsche Messe*,

$$1525–1538$$

(Müntzer in Low German)
- 7.11 Schleswig-Holstein, a Low German Mass from Kiel,

$$after 1526$$

  - 7.11.1 Before the altar: absolution by the sexton, *Veni Sancte Spiritus*, collect
  - 7.11.2 Preface and the bread-word
  - 7.11.3 Exhortation, *Fili Dei vivi*, *Domine non sum dignus*
  - 7.11.4 Communion of the bread; the cup-word and communion of the cup; blessing
- 7.12 Brandenburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1540
  - 7.12.1 Creed, offertory, Preface, Sanctus
  - 7.12.2 The four collects under the Sanctus (in place of the Canon's intercessions)
  - 7.12.3 The Verba, sung, with elevation
  - 7.12.4 Our Father and the Peace
  - 7.12.5 *Agnus Dei* and the priest's three prayers before communion (Latin)
  - 7.12.6 The exhortation (Osiander, Nürnberg 1533)
  - 7.12.7 Communion
  - 7.12.8 Thanksgiving and the two Latin ablution prayers
- 7.13 Calenberg-Göttingen, *Kirchenordnung*, 1542
  - 7.13.1 Offertory, Preface, Sanctus, and the collect under the Sanctus
  - 7.13.2 Our Father, Verba, communion with the *custodiat*, the Peace
  - 7.13.3 Thanksgiving, *Agnus Dei*, and *Qui dixisti* as the final collect
  - 7.13.4 From the Masses for the church year
- 7.14 Pfalz-Neuburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1543
  - 7.14.1 Creed, sermon, and the exhortation before the Lord's Supper
  - 7.14.2 Osiander's prayer over the hosts and cup (offertory and epiclesis)
  - 7.14.3 The Verba, sung, with elevation
  - 7.14.4 Sanctus with three collects
  - 7.14.5 Our Father and the Peace
  - 7.14.6 *Agnus Dei* and the priest's three prayers (Latin)
  - 7.14.7 Communion
  - 7.14.8 Thanksgiving, Latin ablution prayers, *Benedicamus*, blessing
- 7.15 Bugenhagen: the preparatory prayer, and "Hic est noster canon"
  - 7.15.1 Braunschweig-Wolfenbüttel, *Christlike kerken-ordeninge*, 1543
  - 7.15.2 Hildesheim, *Kirchenordnung*, 1544
  - 7.15.3 Schleswig-Holstein, *Christlyke Kercken Ordeninge*, 1542
  - 7.15.4 "Hic est noster canon"
- Appendix 7.A The Canon critique of 1533/1540/1543

- Chapter 8. Hymn Practice
  - 8.1 Summary of findings
    - 8.1.1 The main findings
    - 8.1.2 The slots compared
    - 8.1.3 How the practice changed over the century
  - 8.2 Scope, sources and method
    - 8.2.1 The corpus
    - 8.2.2 How the corpus was searched

        - 8.2.3 Cautions
    - 8.3 The hymn slots in outline
        - 8.3.1 What the orders called the slots
        - 8.3.2 Luther's two orders
        - 8.3.3 A whole service in hymns
        - 8.3.4 Three shapes of service
    - 8.4 The opening of the service
        - 8.4.1 *Veni sancte Spiritus* and "Komm heiliger Geist"
        - 8.4.2 Singing while the people gather
        - 8.4.3 The German Benedictus
        - 8.4.4 The German Te Deum at the opening
        - 8.4.5 A penitential psalm-hymn for the confession
        - 8.4.6 A hymn to cover the priest's prayers at the altar step
        - 8.4.7 How fixed the opening was
    - 8.5 Hymns in place of the introit
        - 8.5.1 The rule: a Scriptural introit, or a German psalm
        - 8.5.2 Which hymns: a short rotating list
        - 8.5.3 Early German Masses: a hymn as the introit itself
        - 8.5.4 A hymn of the feast for the introit
        - 8.5.5 A German prose antiphon as introit
        - 8.5.6 Why a short list: that the people might learn them
        - 8.5.7 How fixed the slot was
    - 8.6 The Kyrie: plain, in three tongues, troped and German
        - 8.6.1 Three times, not nine
        - 8.6.2 In three tongues
        - 8.6.3 Bugenhagen's defence of the Greek Kyrie
        - 8.6.4 Troped Kyries
            - 8.6.4.1 "Kyrie, Gott Vater in Ewigkeit": the *summum* or *Fons bonitatis*
            - 8.6.4.2 "O Herre Gott, Vater in Ewigkeit": the *paschale*
            - 8.6.4.3 "O Vater, allmächtiger Gott": the *Magne Deus*
            - 8.6.4.4 "Ach Vater, allerhöchster Gott"
            - 8.6.4.5 The other Low German Kyries: Schleswig-Holstein and Ritzebüttel
            - 8.6.4.6 Pfalz-Zweibrücken: "Kyrie, Gott aller Welt Schöpfer und Vater"
            - 8.6.4.7 The Latin tropes
        - 8.6.5 The Kyrie and Gloria in one hymn: "Allein Gott"
        - 8.6.6 How fixed the Kyrie was
    - 8.7 The Gloria: "Allein Gott in der Höh" and "All Ehr und Lob"
        - 8.7.1 The German hymn inside the Latin Gloria
        - 8.7.2 Latin one Sunday, German the next
        - 8.7.3 Teaching the people to sing it
        - 8.7.4 Intonation and answer
        - 8.7.5 Left out: Advent, Lent, winter
        - 8.7.6 How fixed the Gloria was
    - 8.8 Between the epistle and the gospel
        - 8.8.1 The rule: a pure sequence, or a German psalm
        - 8.8.2 The sequences cut back to the chief feasts
        - 8.8.3 Farced sequences: Latin verses and German stanzas by turns
        - 8.8.4 German sequences
        - 8.8.5 A hymn in the place of the gradual
        - 8.8.6 A German psalm that "rhymes with the gospel"
        - 8.8.7 Sunday and season tables for this slot
        - 8.8.8 Why the hymn might not change: an unknown tune
        - 8.8.9 The litany in this slot
        - 8.8.10 How fixed the slot was

- 8.9 The creed: "Wir glauben all"
  - 8.9.1 After the gospel, with or instead of the Latin *Patrem*
  - 8.9.2 After the sermon: the creed as the offertory
  - 8.9.3 The creed-hymn to cover the preacher's movement
  - 8.9.4 "Wir glauben" in the place of "Nun bitten"
  - 8.9.5 How fixed the slot was
- 8.10 Before the sermon: "Nun bitten wir" and the old *Leisen*
  - 8.10.1 "Nun bitten" as the prayer before the sermon
  - 8.10.2 The *Leisen* at the high feasts, sung from the pulpit
  - 8.10.3 Seasonal tables for the slot: the Lord's Prayer in Advent and Lent
  - 8.10.4 Chosen to fit the sermon
  - 8.10.5 To cover the preacher's going up
  - 8.10.6 How fixed the slot was
- 8.11 After the sermon: "Erhalt uns", the offertory, and the hymn that answers the sermon
  - 8.11.1 "Erhalt uns, Herr, bei deinem Wort"
  - 8.11.2 To cover the preacher's coming down, or his vesting
  - 8.11.3 A hymn in the place of the offertory
  - 8.11.4 While the communicants come forward
  - 8.11.5 A hymn to answer the sermon
  - 8.11.6 One hymn split around the sermon
  - 8.11.7 How fixed the slot was
- 8.12 The Sanctus: "Jesaia dem Propheten" and "Heilig ist Gott der Vater"
  - 8.12.1 "Jesaia dem Propheten" as the communicants come forward
  - 8.12.2 The Trinitarian German Sanctus
  - 8.12.3 At the elevation
  - 8.12.4 In the place of Sanctus and Agnus
  - 8.12.5 How fixed the slot was
- 8.13 The Lord's Prayer and the Words of Institution
  - 8.13.1 The congregation sings the Lord's Prayer hymn
  - 8.13.2 A communion hymn split around the consecration
- 8.14 Under the communion (*sub communione*)
  - 8.14.1 The core pair
  - 8.14.2 As many hymns as there are communicants
  - 8.14.3 The song stops when the communion ends
  - 8.14.4 Stanzas between the actions
  - 8.14.5 The Latin pieces and the German hymns beside them
  - 8.14.6 Other hymns in the slot
  - 8.14.7 Choir, people and organ
  - 8.14.8 How fixed the slot was
- 8.15 The Agnus Dei, the thanksgiving, and the close
  - 8.15.1 "Christe, du Lamm Gottes" after the communion
  - 8.15.2 "Gott sei gelobet" as the thanksgiving
  - 8.15.3 The closing hymn
  - 8.15.4 The closing hymn covers the priest's devesting
  - 8.15.5 A custom found and left alone
  - 8.15.6 How fixed the slots were
- 8.16 Vespers, matins, the catechism and the weekday services
  - 8.16.1 Office hymns: only of the season, and only if pure
  - 8.16.2 One hymn for a whole season
  - 8.16.3 Latin for the school, German for the people
  - 8.16.4 The German Te Deum sung verse by verse
  - 8.16.5 The evening *Salve* replaced
  - 8.16.6 The catechism service: the hymn of the chief part
  - 8.16.7 Weekday services: reusing the Sunday hymn

        - 8.16.8 The *Benedicamus*: kept, graded and put into German
        - 8.16.9 The *Benedicamus* replaced: motets and German hymns
        - 8.16.10 *Puer natus in Bethlehem* and the festal songs
    - 8.17 Hymns at the occasional rites
        - 8.17.1 Baptism
        - 8.17.2 Weddings
        - 8.17.3 The sick and the dying
        - 8.17.4 Burial
        - 8.17.5 Ordination and installation
        - 8.17.6 Days of thanksgiving and extraordinary occasions
    - 8.18 How hymns were chosen: the reasons given
        - 8.18.1 From Scripture, and "pure"
        - 8.18.2 Fitting the feast and the season
        - 8.18.3 Fitting the gospel and the sermon
        - 8.18.4 That the people may learn them: few, familiar, often repeated
        - 8.18.5 Luther's hymns first
        - 8.18.6 Against private choice and novelty; the authorized books
        - 8.18.7 Latin and German
        - 8.18.8 Length
        - 8.18.9 The organ
        - 8.18.10 Freedom
    - 8.19 Concordance of the orders quoted
    - Appendix 8.A The chief hymn (*Hauptlied*) of each Sunday and feast in the old sources
        - 8.A.1 The witnesses counted
        - 8.A.2 How the table was made
        - 8.A.3 The table
        - 8.A.4 Notes on the table
- Chapter 9. Organ, Instruments and Bells
    - 9.1 Summary of findings
    - 9.2 Scope, sources and method
    - 9.3 The organ
        - 9.3.1 Kept, and defended
        - 9.3.2 The prelude
        - 9.3.3 Interludes and alternation
        - 9.3.4 Organ pieces between the parts of the service
        - 9.3.5 The postlude
        - 9.3.6 When the organ was silent
        - 9.3.7 The organist: what he might not play
    - 9.4 Other instruments
        - 9.4.1 Trombones at the Ansbach court, 1538
        - 9.4.2 Emden (Reformed): the organist as town piper, the carillon and the tower
        - 9.4.3 Danzig: town pipers and fiddlers in the choir, 1612
        - 9.4.4 Weddings: minstrels to the churchyard gate
        - 9.4.5 Drums on the tower at Zwickau
    - 9.5 Bells
        - 9.5.1 What the bells are for
        - 9.5.2 The summons to church
        - 9.5.3 The daily bells: morning, noon and evening, and the prayer for peace
        - 9.5.4 Bells within the Mass
        - 9.5.5 Bells at the *Te Deum*, the litany and other chants
        - 9.5.6 Bells for the dead
        - 9.5.7 Bells at baptisms and weddings
        - 9.5.8 Bells against storms
        - 9.5.9 Lesser signals: the sermon glass and the alms bell

    - 9.6 Table by order
    - 9.7 Concordance of the orders quoted
- Chapter 10. The Daily Office
    - 10.1 Summary of findings
    - 10.2 Scope, sources and cautions
    - 10.3 Luther's rulings, 1523 and 1526
        - 10.3.1 *Von ordenung gottis diensts*, 1523: a morning and an evening gathering
        - 10.3.2 *Formula missae*, 1523: the hours may stay, shortened
        - 10.3.3 *Deutsche Messe*, 1526: a daily office for the schools
        - 10.3.4 The visitors of 1528: the hours as a work
    - 10.4 Where the full cursus survived
        - 10.4.1 Luther's advice: let the chapters and convents keep the hours
        - 10.4.2 Collegiate churches and cathedrals
        - 10.4.3 Bugenhagen's order for the remaining canons and monks
        - 10.4.4 The women's convents
    - 10.5 Where the system was cut down
        - 10.5.1 The case against the hours
        - 10.5.2 Two offices, sung by the school
        - 10.5.3 Decline and transfer
    - 10.6 Who prayed the offices, and under what obligation
        - 10.6.1 The schoolboys
        - 10.6.2 Canons, vicars and altarists: an obligation tied to the benefice
        - 10.6.3 The convents and their pastors
        - 10.6.4 The congregation
        - 10.6.5 The pastors
        - 10.6.6 Students and future pastors
    - 10.7 The shape of the reformed offices
        - 10.7.1 What was kept, cut and added
        - 10.7.2 Bible lessons in place of homilies
        - 10.7.3 A complete morning office: Braunschweig, 1528
        - 10.7.4 Sunday Vespers in a Lutheran town, 1581
        - 10.7.5 The *preces*, the suffrages and the Litany
    - 10.8 Latin, German, or both
        - 10.8.1 Latin: chapters, schools, and the towns
        - 10.8.2 German: convents and villages
        - 10.8.3 Both
    - 10.9 The Office of the Dead
        - 10.9.1 What the vigil was
        - 10.9.2 Why it was abolished
        - 10.9.3 By stages
        - 10.9.4 Chapters, convents and schools
        - 10.9.5 What survived at the funeral
        - 10.9.6 What took its place
        - 10.9.7 Summary by order
    - 10.10 The catechism service
        - 10.10.1 Origins: Luther and Wittenberg
        - 10.10.2 When, and how long
        - 10.10.3 The order of the Lutheran catechism service
        - 10.10.4 The catechism in Vespers
        - 10.10.5 The catechism in the morning service
        - 10.10.6 The Reformed catechism service
        - 10.10.7 The ordo compared
    - 10.11 The music
        - 10.11.1 The old chant kept

        - 10.11.2 The new chant books: Spangenberg and Lossius
        - 10.11.3 German psalm tones
        - 10.11.4 Figural music and the organ
    - 10.12 Ceremonial in the offices and the catechism service
        - 10.12.1 What the orders say, and what they do not
        - 10.12.2 Kneeling to pray
        - 10.12.3 The Litany: boys kneeling before the altar
        - 10.12.4 Kneeling at the evening bell
        - 10.12.5 Two choirs facing
        - 10.12.6 The place of the lesson
        - 10.12.7 The catechism service: the children set in order
        - 10.12.8 The sign of the cross: at home, not in choir
        - 10.12.9 Summary by order
    - 10.13 Table by order
    - 10.14 Concordance of the orders quoted
- Chapter 11. Sermons and Preaching
    - 11.1 Summary of findings
    - 11.2 Scope, sources and cautions
    - 11.3 Luther and the visitors: the sermon first
        - 11.3.1 1523: no gathering without the Word
        - 11.3.2 1526: three sermons on a Sunday
        - 11.3.3 The visitors of 1528: repentance and faith, Wednesday and Friday
    - 11.4 Occasions and times
        - 11.4.1 Sundays and feasts: the gospel in the morning, the catechism after noon
        - 11.4.2 Weekday sermons
        - 11.4.3 Catechism sermons
        - 11.4.4 Lent and the Passion
        - 11.4.5 Prayer days
        - 11.4.6 Funeral sermons
        - 11.4.7 Wedding sermons
    - 11.5 Texts: what was preached on
        - 11.5.1 The Sunday gospels and epistles kept
        - 11.5.2 Books in course on weekdays and at Vespers
        - 11.5.3 The chief articles of doctrine through the year
    - 11.6 How to preach
        - 11.6.1 The shape of a sermon
        - 11.6.2 Law and gospel, repentance and faith
        - 11.6.3 Plain speech for the common man
    - 11.7 Length
        - 11.7.1 An hour on Sunday morning, at most
        - 11.7.2 Half an hour on weekdays and for the catechism
        - 11.7.3 Weather and work
        - 11.7.4 Overrunning
        - 11.7.5 The limits in the orders
    - 11.8 Postils and preparation
        - 11.8.1 Reading a postil from the pulpit
        - 11.8.2 Against preaching from postils
        - 11.8.3 Meditation and writing
    - 11.9 Rebuke, polemic and the limits of the pulpit
        - 11.9.1 Rebuke the vices, name no one
        - 11.9.2 No private grudges in the pulpit
        - 11.9.3 Disputations belong in the schools
    - 11.10 Around the sermon: prayer, greeting, confession, intercession and notices
        - 11.10.1 The medieval pulpit office

        - 11.10.2 The prayer before the sermon
        - 11.10.3 The greeting
        - 11.10.4 After the sermon: confession, intercession and notices
    - 11.11 Preachers: trial sermons, practice and censure
        - 11.11.1 Who preached
        - 11.11.2 The trial sermon
        - 11.11.3 Practice sermons and censure
    - 11.12 Hearers
        - 11.12.1 Attendance
        - 11.12.2 Taverns, markets and games during the sermon
        - 11.12.3 Chattering, sleeping, leaving early
    - 11.13 Table by order
    - 11.14 Concordance of the orders quoted
- Chapter 12. The Liturgical Calendar
    - 12.1 Summary of findings
        - 12.1.1 The main findings
        - 12.1.2 What became of the medieval categories
        - 12.1.3 Terms of rank used in the orders
    - 12.2 Scope, sources and method
        - 12.2.1 The corpus
        - 12.2.2 How the corpus was searched
        - 12.2.3 Cautions
    - 12.3 Why keep feasts at all: the principles behind the ranking
        - 12.3.1 Luther, *Formula missae*, 1523
        - 12.3.2 Homberg, 1526: only the mysteries of redemption
        - 12.3.3 "Not for the days' sake, but for the histories": Bugenhagen
        - 12.3.4 A school timetable of doctrine
        - 12.3.5 Not a commandment of God: a civil and pastoral ordinance
        - 12.3.6 "The feast of all feasts": Hessen, 1566
        - 12.3.7 The test of Scripture history
        - 12.3.8 The Sabbath argument: Sunday first in dignity
    - 12.4 The medieval grades and what became of them
        - 12.4.1 *Duplex*, *semiduplex*, *simplex*: absent
        - 12.4.2 *Summum* and *minus summum*: grades of the chant
        - 12.4.3 Nine lessons and three
        - 12.4.4 Proper, common and *de tempore*
        - 12.4.5 *Ferialiter*, *festive*, *solenniter*
        - 12.4.6 Vigils and first vespers
    - 12.5 The Lutheran scale of feasts
        - 12.5.1 The common pattern
        - 12.5.2 The Saxon and Mecklenburg family: "over and above these chiefest feasts"
        - 12.5.3 The Württemberg family: holy days proclaimed by the magistrate
        - 12.5.4 The Bugenhagen family: "the three great feasts of Christ"
        - 12.5.5 Numbered classes
        - 12.5.6 Great feasts and small feasts: Danzig and Thorn
        - 12.5.7 Wider calendars: the conservative orders
    - 12.6 Whole holy days and half holy days
        - 12.6.1 The half holy day: "until noon"
        - 12.6.2 Tables of whole and half holy days
        - 12.6.3 Counting the rank in sermons
        - 12.6.4 Harvest, markets and the working year
    - 12.7 How many days: the high feasts and their following days
        - 12.7.1 Three days
        - 12.7.2 Two days, and "two only"

        - 12.7.3 St Stephen and St John in Christmas week
    - 12.8 Individual feasts and where they stand
        - 12.8.1 Purification and Annunciation: Marian names, feasts of Christ
        - 12.8.2 The Visitation
        - 12.8.3 The Assumption: abolished, replaced, or kept "for the working peasants"
        - 12.8.4 The other Marian feasts
        - 12.8.5 Michaelmas: the angels and the harvest
        - 12.8.6 John the Baptist
        - 12.8.7 Trinity
        - 12.8.8 Mary Magdalene, the Conversion of Paul, the Beheading of John: kept for their Gospels
        - 12.8.9 Corpus Christi, the Holy Cross, local and new feasts
    - 12.9 The *Vierzeiten*: the four chief feasts and the four offerings
        - 12.9.1 The four times named
        - 12.9.2 Michaelmas in the Assumption's place
        - 12.9.3 The *Vierzeiten* as a liturgical rank
    - 12.10 Keeping the feast in church: ceremonial marks, abolished ceremonies and the seasons
        - 12.10.1 Latin chant on the high feasts
        - 12.10.2 Chant on the apostles' days
        - 12.10.3 Proper prefaces
        - 12.10.4 Sequences
        - 12.10.5 Figural music and the organ
        - 12.10.6 Vestments and elevation
        - 12.10.7 Bells
        - 12.10.8 The Athanasian Creed and the *Te Deum*
        - 12.10.9 Communion and confession
        - 12.10.10 Festal ceremonies abolished
        - 12.10.11 Seasonal changes in the service
    - 12.11 Keeping holy days in common life
        - 12.11.1 Rest: the whole day, the forenoon, or the time of the sermon
        - 12.11.2 Enforcement: gates, fines and taverns
        - 12.11.3 Weddings, guild feasts and markets
        - 12.11.4 Fastnacht, Kirchweih, May Day and Midsummer
        - 12.11.5 Shrove Sunday turned into a feast of baptism
    - 12.12 The seasons of the year
        - 12.12.1 Luther: no special show for Lent
        - 12.12.2 Advent
        - 12.12.3 Lent: repentance, the Passion and the catechism
        - 12.12.4 Holy Week
        - 12.12.5 Rogation week and the catechism seasons
        - 12.12.6 Closed seasons: no weddings in Advent and Lent
        - 12.12.7 The Ember days: from fast days to quarter days
    - 12.13 Fasting
        - 12.13.1 Not a law, and not a merit
        - 12.13.2 Fasting exhorted, but free
        - 12.13.3 Orders that kept the old fasts
        - 12.13.4 Fasting by police order
        - 12.13.5 Days of fasting and prayer
        - 12.13.6 Fasting before communion
    - 12.14 Occurrence and transfer
        - 12.14.1 A feast on a Sunday
        - 12.14.2 The Annunciation in Holy Week
        - 12.14.3 Saturdays, harvests and two feasts in one week
        - 12.14.4 Moving not allowed
    - 12.15 The short calendars: Upper German towns and the Reformed

    - 12.16 Concordance of the orders quoted
- Chapter 13. Extraordinary Rites
    - 13.1 Summary of findings
        - 13.1.1 The main findings
        - 13.1.2 Where the full liturgies are
    - 13.2 Scope, sources and method
        - 13.2.1 The corpus and the rites covered
        - 13.2.2 How the corpus was searched
        - 13.2.3 Cautions
    - 13.3 Baptism
        - 13.3.1 What God instituted and what men added
        - 13.3.2 The received rite: Luther's *Taufbüchlein* of 1523
        - 13.3.3 Luther's revised *Taufbüchlein* of 1526: the Lutheran standard
        - 13.3.4 The Saxon agenda and Brandenburg-Nürnberg: exhortations around Luther's rite
        - 13.3.5 The Upper German rite: Strasbourg and Württemberg
        - 13.3.6 The Reformed rite: the Palatinate 1563
        - 13.3.7 Emergency baptism and its confirmation in church
        - 13.3.8 Godparents, feasts and registers
        - 13.3.9 The baptism of adults and of Jews
    - 13.4 Exorcism
        - 13.4.1 Luther's exorcism and its defenders
        - 13.4.2 No exorcism over the child already baptized
        - 13.4.3 Toleration and mitigation
        - 13.4.4 Abolition
    - 13.5 Churching of women after childbirth
        - 13.5.1 Abolished as a papal superstition
        - 13.5.2 Kept as a thanksgiving: the *Kirchgang*
    - 13.6 Confirmation
        - 13.6.1 The reformers' proposal
        - 13.6.2 Hesse 1539: the Ziegenhain and Kassel forms
        - 13.6.3 A full form: Calenberg-Göttingen 1542
        - 13.6.4 Brandenburg 1540: confirmation by the bishop
        - 13.6.5 Mansfeld 1580 and Pomerania 1569: confirmation before first communion
        - 13.6.6 Strasbourg and the south-west
        - 13.6.7 Examination without a rite: Electoral Saxony
    - 13.7 Betrothal, marriage and divorce
        - 13.7.1 Luther's *Traubüchlein*
        - 13.7.2 The South German form: Brandenburg-Nürnberg 1533
        - 13.7.3 Strasbourg 1537: the impediments asked thrice
        - 13.7.4 The nuptial Mass replaced
        - 13.7.5 Days, hours and banns
        - 13.7.6 The bride who had fallen: no wreath
        - 13.7.7 Widows and widowers
        - 13.7.8 Betrothal
        - 13.7.9 Breaking a betrothal
        - 13.7.10 Divorce, annulment and the remarriage of the innocent party
    - 13.8 The sick, the dying, the condemned and the possessed
        - 13.8.1 Extreme unction
        - 13.8.2 No reserved sacrament: communion in the house
        - 13.8.3 The Saxon form for the sick, 1539
        - 13.8.4 The dying
        - 13.8.5 Plague
        - 13.8.6 The condemned
        - 13.8.7 The possessed: prayer instead of exorcism

- 13.9 Funerals and burial
  - 13.9.1 What was abolished
  - 13.9.2 The Saxon burial, 1539–1540
  - 13.9.3 The Franconian burial: Brandenburg-Nürnberg 1533
  - 13.9.4 Who received Christian burial
- 13.10 Ordination
  - 13.10.1 Why the evangelicals ordained
  - 13.10.2 The Wittenberg form, 1537–1539
  - 13.10.3 Ordination within the Mass: Merseburg 1545
  - 13.10.4 Regensburg 1553: the Spirit as the "true priestly ordination and unction"
  - 13.10.5 Ordination in the parish: Hesse 1574 and the Palatinate 1592
- 13.11 Installation of pastors, superintendents, abbots and bishops
  - 13.11.1 The Saxon investiture, 1580
  - 13.11.2 Presentation in the Reformed Palatinate, 1592
  - 13.11.3 The evangelical abbots of Württemberg
  - 13.11.4 Bishops and superintendents
- 13.12 Minor orders, lay offices, church workers and religious communities
  - 13.12.1 The minor orders and the lay offices of the congregation
  - 13.12.2 Sextons
  - 13.12.3 Schoolmasters, cantors and organists
  - 13.12.4 Churchwardens and stewards
  - 13.12.5 Midwives
  - 13.12.6 Deaconesses and sick-women
  - 13.12.7 The clothing of a nun: Keppel 1570
  - 13.12.8 The *domina*, the abbess and the prioress
  - 13.12.9 Monks, novices and evangelical abbots
  - 13.12.10 Laying aside the habit
- 13.13 Magistrates and civil offices
  - 13.13.1 The council-election sermon
  - 13.13.2 Prayer for the magistrate
  - 13.13.3 Oaths of homage
- 13.14 Dedication of churches and the *Kirchweih*
  - 13.14.1 Dedication rejected
  - 13.14.2 Opening a new church or churchyard
  - 13.14.3 Hof: the dedication of 1572 and its yearly festival
  - 13.14.4 The *Kirchweih* festival
- 13.15 Blessings of objects and their abolition
  - 13.15.1 The lists of abolished blessings
  - 13.15.2 What was kept in place of the blessing
  - 13.15.3 The blessing of the font
  - 13.15.4 Chrism and holy oils
  - 13.15.5 Bells and weather-ringing
  - 13.15.6 Wreaths and other signs
- 13.16 The ban, excommunication, public penance and reconciliation
  - 13.16.1 Lesser and greater ban
  - 13.16.2 The Lutheran form of excommunication: Wittenberg 1542
  - 13.16.3 The full Lutheran rite: Saxe-Lauenburg 1585
  - 13.16.4 The Mecklenburg consistory order of 1570
  - 13.16.5 Mansfeld 1580: discipline, the ban and open penance
  - 13.16.6 Grubenhagen 1581: the form of absolution from the ban
  - 13.16.7 The Reformed form: Micron's London order
  - 13.16.8 Other orders
- 13.17 Private confession and absolution
  - 13.17.1 The Lutheran position

        - 13.17.2 The form of confession: Luther's catechism
        - 13.17.3 The form of absolution: Brandenburg 1540
        - 13.17.4 Without private confession: the examination of communicants
    - 13.18 Processions
        - 13.18.1 Abolished
        - 13.18.2 Kept and purified: Electoral Brandenburg 1540
        - 13.18.3 Processions that remained
        - 13.18.4 Who walked and what was carried
    - 13.19 Tonsure, deconsecration and the deposition of ministers
        - 13.19.1 The tonsure abolished
        - 13.19.2 Churches, altars and vessels returned to common use
        - 13.19.3 The deposition of ministers
    - 13.20 Sorcery and the cleansing of houses and things
        - 13.20.1 The old means of cleansing abolished
        - 13.20.2 A house troubled by the devil: prayer
        - 13.20.3 The tools of sorcery burned
        - 13.20.4 Images, fonts and chapels of the old cult
        - 13.20.5 The things of the sacraments guarded
        - 13.20.6 The persons: repentance, not purification
    - 13.21 The litany, the suffrages and the bidding prayers at the Mass
        - 13.21.1 The Litany in place of the Mass
        - 13.21.2 The Litany within the Mass
        - 13.21.3 The forms and the singers
        - 13.21.4 The Litany days
        - 13.21.5 The Litany at the feasts and seasons
        - 13.21.6 Good Friday: the Litany and the solemn prayers
    - 13.22 Other occasional rites
        - 13.22.1 The visitation service
        - 13.22.2 Rites treated in other chapters
        - 13.22.3 Reservation of the sacrament
        - 13.22.4 Good Friday: no Mass of the Presanctified
        - 13.22.5 The remaining elements consumed
    - 13.23 Rites of the feasts and seasons
        - 13.23.1 The pattern
        - 13.23.2 Christmas and the night vigils
        - 13.23.3 Candlemas, Ash Wednesday and Palm Sunday
        - 13.23.4 Maundy Thursday and Good Friday
        - 13.23.5 Easter Eve and Easter
        - 13.23.6 Ascension and Whitsun
        - 13.23.7 Septuagesima and Trinity Sunday
    - 13.24 Table by order
    - 13.25 Concordance of the orders quoted
- Chapter 14. Art, Architecture, Paraments and Vestments
    - 14.1 Summary of findings
    - 14.2 Scope, sources and method
        - 14.2.1 Sources
        - 14.2.2 Searches
        - 14.2.3 What was not found
        - 14.2.4 Method
    - 14.3 Things indifferent
        - 14.3.1 The principle
        - 14.3.2 Keep what each church has
        - 14.3.3 Kept for peace and for the weak
        - 14.3.4 The limit

    - 14.4 Images and crucifixes
        - 14.4.1 Idols and histories
        - 14.4.2 Orderly removal
        - 14.4.3 New pictures
        - 14.4.4 The Reformed clearances
        - 14.4.5 The crucifix
        - 14.4.6 Banners, processional crosses and image plays
    - 14.5 The building and its furnishings
        - 14.5.1 How many altars
        - 14.5.2 Where the minister stands
        - 14.5.3 Tables in place of altars
        - 14.5.4 Lights
        - 14.5.5 The sacrament house
        - 14.5.6 The font
        - 14.5.7 Pulpit, screens, pews, galleries and windows
    - 14.6 Paraments, linens and vessels
        - 14.6.1 Covers for altar, pulpit and font
        - 14.6.2 Corporal and pall
        - 14.6.3 The communion cloth
        - 14.6.4 The stock of vestments
        - 14.6.5 Chalices and beakers
        - 14.6.6 Colours and the seasons
        - 14.6.7 The paten, the host box and the bread dish
    - 14.7 Vestments
        - 14.7.1 The Mass vestment kept
        - 14.7.2 The cope when there is no communion
        - 14.7.3 Vestments abolished
        - 14.7.4 The surplice
        - 14.7.5 What the orders do not mention
    - 14.8 Clerical dress outside the service
    - 14.9 Table by order
    - 14.10 Concordance of the orders quoted
- Chapter 15. Ecclesiastical Duties
    - 15.1 Summary of findings
    - 15.2 Scope, sources and method
        - 15.2.1 Sources and searches
        - 15.2.2 What was not found
    - 15.3 Pastors and deacons
        - 15.3.1 The office in a list
        - 15.3.2 Study and the pastor's books
        - 15.3.3 Life, household and conduct
        - 15.3.4 Residence and records
        - 15.3.5 Deacons and chaplains
    - 15.4 Superintendents and deans
        - 15.4.1 The name and the office
        - 15.4.2 Electoral Saxony, 1555–1557: visitation, synod, report
        - 15.4.3 The superintendent's charge: Grubenhagen, 1600
        - 15.4.4 Deans of the Transylvanian chapters
    - 15.5 Consistories, their presidents and members
        - 15.5.1 Composition: theologians and jurists
        - 15.5.2 The president: prince, nobleman or councillor
        - 15.5.3 The business of the consistory
    - 15.6 Professors of theology
    - 15.7 Training of ministers

        - 15.7.1 School, university and stipend
        - 15.7.2 Practice preaching in the stipend: Tübingen, 1559
        - 15.7.3 Examination, trial sermon and instruction before ordination
        - 15.7.4 Probation: deacon before pastor
        - 15.7.5 Continuing study: synods, convents and assigned reading
    - 15.8 The laity
        - 15.8.1 Attending church
        - 15.8.2 Prayer and teaching at home
        - 15.8.3 Confession and communion
        - 15.8.4 Church workers: a higher standard
    - 15.9 Schoolmasters
        - 15.9.1 A church office
        - 15.9.2 In church with the boys
        - 15.9.3 Girls' schools and schoolmistresses
        - 15.9.4 Oversight
    - 15.10 The magistrate
        - 15.10.1 Keeper of both tables
        - 15.10.2 What the magistrate did
        - 15.10.3 The Reformed limit
    - 15.11 Catechesis: where the estates meet
        - 15.11.1 How often and how long
        - 15.11.2 Before first communion
        - 15.11.3 First communion and confirmation
        - 15.11.4 Before marriage
        - 15.11.5 Premarital instruction and counsel
        - 15.11.6 Infant communion
    - 15.12 Table by order
    - 15.13 Concordance of the orders quoted
- Chapter 16. Minor Orders, Deacons and Elders
    - 16.1 Summary of findings
    - 16.2 Scope, sources and the words that mislead
    - 16.3 The minor orders and the subdiaconate
        - 16.3.1 Strasbourg: a short history of the grades
        - 16.3.2 Homberg 1526: "Scripture knoweth no other ministers"
        - 16.3.3 Human ordinances, tonsure and vestment
        - 16.3.4 The one exception: the acolytes of the Bohemian Brethren
        - 16.3.5 Where the functions went
    - 16.4 The liturgical roles
        - 16.4.1 Ministrants
        - 16.4.2 Deacon and subdeacon at the altar
        - 16.4.3 Levites: kept, then abolished
        - 16.4.4 Thurifer, boat-bearer and candle-bearer
        - 16.4.5 Cross-bearer, and the roles not found
    - 16.5 The diaconate
        - 16.5.1 The Lutheran *Diaconus*: an assistant minister, ordained like a pastor
        - 16.5.2 Lay deacons of the poor in the Lutheran orders
        - 16.5.3 Hesse, the Reformed churches and the Bohemian Brethren: deacons as an ordained lay office
        - 16.5.4 Divine right or human right?
    - 16.6 Elders
        - 16.6.1 Strasbourg: the disciplinary *seniores*
        - 16.6.2 Hesse: elders elected, "sanctified" and finally ordained
        - 16.6.3 The Reformed orders: four offices, elders who govern with the ministers
        - 16.6.4 The Bohemian Brethren: lay presbyters and *presbyterae*
        - 16.6.5 The Lutheran orders: churchwardens and clerical seniors

    - 16.7 Sacristans, altar care, deaconesses and the religious life
        - 16.7.1 Sacristans
        - 16.7.2 Altar care: no altar guild
        - 16.7.3 Deaconesses, sick-women and *Seelfrauen*
        - 16.7.4 Monks
        - 16.7.5 Nuns
        - 16.7.6 Beguines, tertiaries, Brethren of the Common Life and confraternities
    - 16.8 Ordained or not: how each office was installed
    - 16.9 Women and laymen in the church's services
        - 16.9.1 Summary of findings
        - 16.9.2 "Let your women keep silence": the rule
        - 16.9.3 Women and the offices of governance
        - 16.9.4 Women in the lesser offices: sexton, schoolmistress and midwife
        - 16.9.5 Women reading and praying aloud
        - 16.9.6 Women singing, and who led the singing
        - 16.9.7 Laymen at the Lord's Table
        - 16.9.8 Laymen leading prayer and reading in church
        - 16.9.9 Who read the prayer bids
    - 16.10 Table by order
    - 16.11 Concordance of the orders quoted
- Chapter 17. Confessional Subscription
    - 17.1 Summary of findings
        - 17.1.1 The main findings
        - 17.1.2 The pattern by region
    - 17.2 Scope, sources and method
        - 17.2.1 What was searched
        - 17.2.2 What the chapter does not do
        - 17.2.3 Cautions
        - 17.2.4 How to read the regional sections
    - 17.3 The documents the orders name
        - 17.3.1 The ancient creeds
        - 17.3.2 The Lutheran confessions
        - 17.3.3 Melanchthon and the Philippist corpora
        - 17.3.4 Territorial corpora and local confessions
        - 17.3.5 Reformed documents
    - 17.4 The forms of binding
    - 17.5 Albertine (Electoral) Saxony
        - 17.5.1 The CA and the *Loci* as a book list (1540, 1557)
        - 17.5.2 The *Corpus doctrinae Philippicum* (1560–1574)
        - 17.5.3 The Book of Concord as the condition of office (1580)
    - 17.6 Ernestine Saxony, Henneberg, the Harz counties, Magdeburg, Halberstadt and Anhalt
        - 17.6.1 Ernestine Saxony: from the book list to the public confession (1554, 1569)
        - 17.6.2 Henneberg: the visitation question, subscription and the ordination vow (1574–1582)
        - 17.6.3 Mansfeld: the county's own confession of 1565 and the Book of Concord (1580, 1586)
        - 17.6.4 Archbishopric of Magdeburg: the visitation question (1583)
        - 17.6.5 Halberstadt: the Brunswick corpus (1588)
        - 17.6.6 Anhalt: the refusal
    - 17.7 Silesia, Prussia, the Polish cities and Pomerania
        - 17.7.1 Silesia: Brieg (1592)
        - 17.7.2 Ducal Prussia: the *Corpus doctrinae Prutenicum* (1567) and the assessors' oath (1584)
        - 17.7.3 Thorn, Elbing and Danzig: a royal corpus and the city *Notel* (1575, 1586, 1612)
        - 17.7.4 Pomerania: the Melanchthonian corpus (1563/69) and the synodal handshake (1574)
    - 17.8 Mecklenburg, Kurland, Lauenburg and Schleswig-Holstein
        - 17.8.1 Mecklenburg and Rostock (1552, 1573)

        - 17.8.2 Kurland: the Wittenberg *Corpus doctrinae* (1570)
        - 17.8.3 Lauenburg: the FC as an alternative (1585)
        - 17.8.4 Schleswig-Holstein (Gottorp): an oath instead of the Concord (1574, 1607)
    - 17.9 Braunschweig-Wolfenbüttel, Lüneburg, Calenberg-Göttingen, Hoya and Goslar
        - 17.9.1 Braunschweig-Wolfenbüttel: the CA "in the sense" of the Apology, the SA and the catechism (1569)
        - 17.9.2 Brunswick city: articles to be subscribed (1571)
        - 17.9.3 Lüneburg: the duchy's confession (1564) and the city's corpus (1575)
        - 17.9.4 Calenberg-Göttingen: the *Corpus Julium* (1601) and Göttingen's own order (1568)
        - 17.9.5 Hoya: the FC in the church order (1581)
        - 17.9.6 Goslar: a city corpus signed "with our own hands" (1591/95)
    - 17.10 Hildesheim, Verden, Osnabrück, Oldenburg, Bremen, East Frisia and Soest
        - 17.10.1 Hildesheim: the Peine oath (1574/89) and the subscription of the city's officials (1593)
        - 17.10.2 Verden: the CA "in the sense" of the Apology, the SA and the catechisms (1606)
        - 17.10.3 Osnabrück: the Wittenberg Concord and the Book of Concord (1610)
        - 17.10.4 Oldenburg: the *Corpus Philippicum* (1573), then the FC (1586–1609)
        - 17.10.5 Bremen: the *Corpus Philippicum* and the road to the Reformed (1570–1575)
        - 17.10.6 East Frisia: "the Augsburg Confession" and nothing more (1593, 1599)
        - 17.10.7 Soest: "our *corpus doctrinae*", subscribed before admission (1590)
    - 17.11 Hesse, Waldeck, Frankfurt, Nassau and Ysenburg
        - 17.11.1 Hesse: the synod, the Agende, and the divided landgraviate (1571–1617)
        - 17.11.2 Waldeck: the FC in the ordination vow
        - 17.11.3 Frankfurt: the Book of Concord in the ordination vow (1589)
        - 17.11.4 Nassau: from Melanchthon's *Loci* to the Reformed confession (1564–1582)
        - 17.11.5 Nassau-Weilburg and Ysenburg: the unaltered CA (1576, 1588)
    - 17.12 The Palatinates: Kurpfalz, the Upper Palatinate, Pfalz-Neuburg, Pfalz-Zweibrücken and Sponheim
        - 17.12.1 Kurpfalz: one formula, four confessions (1556–1601)
        - 17.12.2 The Upper Palatinate: released from the Book of Concord (1585)
        - 17.12.3 Pfalz-Neuburg: the Wittenberg Concord against the Calvinists (1564), the *corpus doctrinae* (1576)
        - 17.12.4 Pfalz-Zweibrücken: "I subscribe with mind and hand" (1564)
        - 17.12.5 Sponheim: the FC as "the symbol of all pure churches" (1608)
    - 17.13 Württemberg, Hohenlohe and the Swabian cities
        - 17.13.1 Württemberg: the CA and the *Loci* (1547), the CA and "our Confession" (after 1559)
        - 17.13.2 Württemberg: the mandate to sign the FC (1577)
        - 17.13.3 Hohenlohe: an own corpus (1578), cut down (1581), and the *Gründlicher Bericht* (1603–1615)
        - 17.13.4 Ulm and Limpurg
        - 17.13.5 Schwäbisch Hall, Wimpfen and Ravensburg
    - 17.14 Franconia and Regensburg
        - 17.14.1 Brandenburg-Ansbach: the priest's oath (1528, 1570, 1573, 1588)
        - 17.14.2 Nürnberg and its neighbours: the 1573 *norma doctrinae* and the refusal of the FC
        - 17.14.3 Regensburg: the CA "in its right sense" (1567), the BoC signed before the consistory (1572/1588)
    - 17.15 Strasbourg and Alsace
        - 17.15.1 The CA in the examination (1549)
        - 17.15.2 "*Stipulata manu*" (1562) and "*corde et manu*" (1577); the FC in the ordination vow (1598)
        - 17.15.3 Colmar: an oath on the CA, and the refusal of the FC (1575, 1578)
    - 17.16 Transylvania
    - 17.17 The laity: confirmation, communion, godparents, citizenship and office
        - 17.17.1 Confirmation: profession, vow and discipline
        - 17.17.2 Admission to communion
        - 17.17.3 Marriage and citizenship
        - 17.17.4 Godparents
        - 17.17.5 Magistrates and officials
    - 17.18 Table by order
    - 17.19 Concordance of the orders quoted
- Chapter 18. Church Fellowship Between the Traditions

    - 18.1 Summary of findings
        - 18.1.1 The main findings
        - 18.1.2 Who could do what with whom
    - 18.2 Scope, sources and method
        - 18.2.1 What was searched
        - 18.2.2 Cautions
    - 18.3 The language of fellowship
    - 18.4 Baptism
        - 18.4.1 Baptism given by others
        - 18.4.2 The children of others
        - 18.4.3 Godparents of another confession
    - 18.5 The Lord's Supper
        - 18.5.1 Closed to those of another confession
        - 18.5.2 Strangers and the parish
        - 18.5.3 Communicants from Catholic and Reformed parishes
        - 18.5.4 Going out to another church (*Auslaufen*)
    - 18.6 Confession and absolution
        - 18.6.1 Not from monks and priests
        - 18.6.2 Not to the defenders of error
        - 18.6.3 One's own confessor
    - 18.7 Ordination
        - 18.7.1 Orders received from the bishops
        - 18.7.2 Re-ordination, and orders taken from the papists
        - 18.7.3 Proof of orders
    - 18.8 Preaching
        - 18.8.1 No preaching without a call
        - 18.8.2 Strangers in the pulpit
        - 18.8.3 The other confession's ministers, and the pulpit
    - 18.9 Prayer and worship side by side
        - 18.9.1 Prayer for, and against, the other confessions
        - 18.9.2 At the other confession's worship
        - 18.9.3 Two religions in one town
    - 18.10 Burial and marriage
        - 18.10.1 Burial
        - 18.10.2 Marriage between spouses of unequal religion
    - 18.11 Agreements between the traditions
        - 18.11.1 The Wittenberg Concord and its memory
        - 18.11.2 Prussia and the Bohemian Brethren, 1549
        - 18.11.3 Poland: the Consensus of Sandomierz and its synods
        - 18.11.4 Two congregations under one lord
    - 18.12 How the rules changed
    - 18.13 Table by order
    - 18.14 Concordance of the orders quoted
- Scripture index
- Index of persons
- Glossary

Introduction

This book describes the worship and the church life of the evangelical churches of the Reformation in Germany and the neighbouring lands, as their own church orders laid them down. A church order (*Kirchenordnung*) is the law that a prince or a city council gave its church. It says who shall preach and what, how the Lord's Supper, baptism and marriage are to be held, which feasts are kept, how ministers are examined and bound, and how the schools and the poor are provided for. The orders read here are those printed in Emil Sehling's edition, *Die evangelischen Kirchenordnungen des XVI. Jahrhunderts* (The Evangelical Church Orders of the Sixteenth Century): 2,581 texts, dated from 1521 to 1620.

The book is written chiefly for Lutherans who want to know what the first Lutheran churches did: which parts of the Mass they kept and which they dropped, what they sang, how they prayed, preached and kept the church year, and how they ordered their ministries. The orders are left to speak for themselves. Each chapter quotes them in a close English translation and cites every passage to its page in Sehling. This edition gives the English alone; the full edition also prints each quotation in its original language (Conventions). Orders of other traditions are used where they show the practice of their time, and they are always marked as such (Conventions).

The source: Sehling's edition

Emil Sehling, professor of law at Erlangen, began the edition in 1902. By 1913 he had published five volumes at Leipzig, covering Saxony and Thuringia, Brandenburg, Lusatia and Silesia, Prussia, Poland and Pomerania, and the Baltic lands, Mecklenburg, Lübeck, Lauenburg and Hamburg. The Institute for Evangelical Church Law of the Evangelical Church in Germany, at Göttingen, took up the work again in 1955. The Heidelberg Academy of Sciences carried it on, publishing its volumes from 2004, and completed it in 2017. The edition runs to 24 volumes in 30 parts, with two volumes of registers.

Each volume treats a group of territories: principalities and counties, bishoprics, imperial cities and towns, from the North Sea to Transylvania. For each territory an editor's introduction tells the history of its reformation and describes its orders. The orders follow, with their variants and notes. Sehling took "church order" in the widest sense (§1.2.1), so the set holds visitation articles, mandates, consistory and school orders, marriage and poor-law orders, agendas and confessions as well as the great church orders.

Of the 2,581 texts, 1,950 are Lutheran. The rest are Reformed, Moderate Reformed and Philippist, with a few of other traditions (§1.3). Sehling meant to print no orders made for the Augsburg Interim of 1548, and only four are in the set (§1.4). The texts run from Breslau's beggars' order of 1521 to the orders of 1620 for Stade, Limpurg and the Transylvanian Saxons. One later text, a report of 1635 on the consistory of Henneberg, stands outside that range.

How the book is arranged

Chapter 1 is an inventory of every order in the edition, volume by volume and territory by territory, with its date, its kind, its confessional tradition and whether it belongs to the Interim. Each of the other chapters takes one subject through the whole edition:

- the Mass: its order as a whole (Chapter 2), the preliminaries, confession and exhortation (Chapter 3), the propers (Chapter 4), the collects (Chapter 5), the general prayer (Chapter 6), and the Canon in the German Masses (Chapter 7);
- music: hymns (Chapter 8), and the organ, other instruments and bells (Chapter 9);
- the daily office (Chapter 10), preaching (Chapter 11) and the church year (Chapter 12);
- the occasional and extraordinary rites, from baptism to the rites of the feasts and seasons, among them what was done with houses and things that sorcery had touched, and the Litany (Chapter 13);
- the furnishing of worship: art, architecture, paraments and vestments (Chapter 14);
- the duties of ministers, officers and people (Chapter 15), and the ministries themselves: minor orders, deacons and elders, and what women and laymen might do in the services (Chapter 16);
- confessional subscription (Chapter 17), and church fellowship between the confessional traditions (Chapter 18).

Most chapters open with a summary of findings and a section on scope, sources and method. They then set out the evidence subject by subject, quoting the orders and translating them. Tables by order follow, and every chapter ends with a concordance of the orders it quotes.

Sections are numbered within their chapter, with the chapter number first: §2.3.2 is section 3.2 of Chapter 2. Every reference to a section is a link, and so is every entry in the Contents. The Scripture index and the Index of persons list the sections where each passage of Scripture and each person is cited, and the Glossary explains the rarer terms.

The repository and its methods

The book was made from a digital copy of Sehling's edition and from databases built from it. They are kept, with the programs that built them, in a public repository: https://github.com/sethkasten/sehling-corpus. The chapters sometimes name these files. This section describes them, so that the book can be read without the repository.

The digital corpus

The corpus is the text of all 24 volumes, in their 30 parts, and of the two register volumes. It was taken from the digitized edition of the Heidelberg Academy of Sciences (digi.hadw-bw.de) and divided into documents. Each document carries:

- Sehling's citation, for example "Sehling 7, I/Bremen Nr. 3";
- its heading, with place and year;
- its range of printed pages;
- its full text, as read by optical character recognition (OCR).

Two limits of the corpus matter for the quotations in this book. Sehling's footnotes, variant readings and editorial brackets stand in the text as printed, mixed with the order itself, because OCR loses the type that tells them apart. They are left out when a passage is quoted (Conventions). And the OCR is not corrected in the corpus, so a quotation can keep a misreading, as the Conventions describe.

Three pairs of half-volumes, 7/1 and 7/2.2, 17/1 and 17/2, and 20/1 and 20/2, were bound as separate books that each number their pages from the beginning. A page number alone is therefore ambiguous in these volumes, and this book always names the half-volume.

The corpus database (`eko.db`)

`eko.db` is a SQLite database built from the corpus. It holds 2,368 records, one for each document, from the 32 digitized volumes and half-volumes, register volumes included. Each record gives the citation, heading, place, title, year and pages of its document, a link to the facsimile page images, and the full text, which can be searched word by word. The database also holds Sehling's registers of persons, places and subjects, 24,168 entries in all, each linked to the documents it points to. The registers find mentions that a word search would miss, such as older spellings and Latin forms.

The "Doc" numbers in the tables and concordances of this book are the record numbers of `eko.db`. Every quotation is preceded by an invisible note naming the record it was checked against. A record is a unit of the digitized edition, not always one order: one record may hold several short orders, and a long order may run over several records. The database's year and heading for a record are sometimes wrong, so this book names every order from Sehling's running heads instead (see, for example, §8.2.3).

The database is about 120 MB. It is not kept in the repository, but is rebuilt from the corpus by the program `build_database.py`.

How the chapters were made

Each chapter was made in the same way.

- **Search.** The whole corpus was searched in `eko.db` for the words of the subject in High German, Low German, Dutch and Latin, in their period spellings, and, where useful, through Sehling's registers. Each hit was read in its context.
- **Findings.** What each order prescribes was recorded order by order. Where a thing was looked for and not found, the chapter says so. These negative findings are part of the evidence.
- **Quotations.** Every quotation was checked against the text of its record in `eko.db`, and its page against the edition's page markers (Conventions).
- **Translations** were made from the original, in the idiom of the Authorized Version (Conventions).

- **Traditions.** Each order's confessional tradition and Interim status was fixed once, in the inventory of Chapter 1. The other chapters mark the orders they cite by that inventory (Conventions).

Each chapter's own section on scope, sources and method gives its searches, its sources and its cautions: §1.2, §2.2, §3.2, §4.2, §5.2, §6.2, §7.1.3, §8.2, §9.2, §10.2, §11.2, §12.2, §13.2, §14.2, §15.2, §16.2 and §17.2.

The hymn database (`hymns.db`)

`hymns.db`, with its workbook `hymns.xlsx`, holds the **chief-hymn prescriptions**: the places where a church order, a hymnal or a later list assigns a hymn to a particular Sunday, feast or occasion. Chapter 8 treats where and how hymns were sung. The database holds the tables of hymns by day, and Appendix 8.A condenses its "Compare by day" sheet.

The database holds 4,135 prescriptions from 50 witnesses, in two layers that must be kept apart:

- **The church orders.** 466 prescriptions come from the eight orders in Sehling that carry a table of hymns: Pomerania 1569, Pfalz-Zweibrücken 1565, Hof 1592, Weissenfels 1578, Mansfeld 1580, Hohenlohe 1596, Nördlingen 1579 and Heilbronn 1543. All are Lutheran. Weissenfels comes nearest to the later table of one hymn for each Sunday. The word *Hauptlied* does not occur in the corpus. It is later terminology.
- **The hymnals and compilations.** 3,669 prescriptions come from later books and lists:
  - Liliencron's concordance of fifteen hymnals of 1545–1694, Sunday by Sunday;
  - Ludecus's *Ordo cantionum Germanicarum* (1589);
  - Selnecker's own account of the scheme he kept;
  - a modern Hymn of the Day table, which collates the schemes of Selnecker, Carpzov and others with those of modern hymnals;
  - Krusemark's *Hymns ABC* (2018), of which only the hymns of the day are taken.

An order commands what shall be sung. A hymnal records what was sung, sometimes long after.

Witnesses, not books, are counted. A witness is counted once, whichever compilation it was read from. Selnecker, for instance, appears in Liliencron, in the Hymn of the Day table and in his own account, and he counts once. One overlap could not be resolved. A column of Krusemark's, taken from Jason Thompson's dissertation, collates Ludecus with twelve other lists of the sixteenth century without saying which list each hymn came from. Where that column and Ludecus agree, Ludecus may be counted twice.

Titles. Each hymn is named by its German or Latin incipit as printed, with a literal English rendering. Where the hymn has a received English title, that title is given as well. For 36 hymns with no received title, the title of Matthew Carver's translation is given, from *Walther's Hymnal* (2012) or from his *Hymnoglypt*. 38 hymns have no English title at all. Where a hymn has rival English titles, the choice between them is an editorial judgment, not a fact.

Assignments. On five days where no hymn has three old witnesses, the editor of the database assigns one. These are marked "Assigned" and never counted as witnesses.

The general-prayer workbook and database (`general_prayers.db`)

`general_prayers.db`, with its workbook `general_prayers.xlsx`, holds the general prayer of the Sunday service (Chapter 6) from every order in Sehling that prints one: 57 orders, dated 1526–1618. The orders give 455 petitions, which fall into 18 families of text and 28 standard categories of intention. Their languages are High German, Low German, Low Dutch and Latin.

Each petition is divided into its rubric (the heading or marginal note), its bid (the words addressed to the people) and its prayer (the words addressed to God). Each part is given in English here; the workbook and the full edition also give the original.

How the texts were made. The original is Sehling's base text with his editorial matter stripped out: sigla, footnote numbers, the variant readings of later editions, page and folio markers, running heads, and words interleaved from the second column by the OCR. The spelling of the print is kept, and obvious OCR slips are corrected. Every rubric, bid and prayer was found again in its record in `eko.db`, with at least nine-tenths of its words. Where one order copies another, the source's English was taken over and corrected wherever the German differs. Each witness is dated as Sehling edits it, not by the year of its record in `eko.db`, which is wrong for several of them.

The sheets of the workbook.

- The **Compare** sheet sets the orders side by side, petition by petition.
- The **Prayers** sheet gives every witness's own text.
- The **Archetypes** sheet and four **Critical** sheets collate each family's witnesses into one text for each category, with every variant in square brackets.
- Four **Representative** sheets give one clean text for each family and category. Chapter 6 prints these, family by family.

What counts as the general prayer

Included. The prayer of intercession for all estates and needs in the chief Sunday service. It is normally after the sermon, from the pulpit. In family L it is in the Mass itself, and in Norden 1528 (Reformed) it stands in the place of the Prone. The following count as part of it:

- an exhortation or preface to it;
- confession and absolution, when the order places them inside the prayer;
- the Our Father, the Creed or the Decalogue, when printed as its close.

Two orders that *prescribe the contents* of the prayer in indirect speech are also included: Magdeburg 1562 and Osnabrück 1543.

Excluded, deliberately:

- **Collect banks**, even when they supply the texts for the prayer: Wittenberg 1536, Brandenburg-Nürnberg 1533, Mansfeld 1562, Lippe 1566, Grubenhagen, Hoya, the Prussian collects and Hanau-Lichtenberg's "XII Collecten" (Twelve Collects).
- **The Litany.** It is often the alternative form, and it is a genre of its own.
- **Prayer-day, occasional and emergency prayers**, such as the three prayers of the Wild- and Rhinegraves and the variant in the Nassau *Agende* of 1618.
- **Afternoon, weekday and Vespers forms**, such as the afternoon forms of Henneberg, Strasbourg 1598 and Kurpfalz 1563 (Reformed).
- **Orders that only mention the prayer, or give it by reference**: Strasbourg 1577, Hessen 1574 (Philippist), Mecklenburg 1552, Sponheim 1590, Emden 1594 (Reformed; free prayer), Saxony 1539 (Luther's paraphrase, by reference only), and the references to Veit Dietrich's collects.
- **Orders that Sehling prints only as variants of another order.** Kurpfalz 1601 (Reformed) is identical to 1563.

Representative texts

The representative texts give one clean text for each family and category, with no brackets. They are built from the same collation as the critical texts, by five rules.

1. **Layout.** A representative cell is filled exactly where the critical cell is.
2. **Majority.** A petition is kept if at least half the family's witnesses to that category have it. Within a petition, a rubric, bid or prayer is kept if at least half its witnesses have it. Word by word:
    - a variant replaces the parent's reading only if at least half the witnesses to that text have it, and more have it than have the parent's reading;
    - an addition is kept if at least half the witnesses to that text have it.
3. **Moved words.** A transposition appears in the collation as an omission at one place and an addition at another. Both are decided by the votes above, so the order that more witnesses have wins. On a tie the parent's order is kept: an addition that exactly half the witnesses have is dropped when its words already stand in the parent close by.
4. **Consistent openings and endings.** Within each family one pattern is applied, taken from the family's own majority:
    - **A (Brenz):** bids end "Bittend also:" (*Pray ye thus*:). Collects end bare, as in Schwäbisch Hall 1526. The mediation formula and Amen that two collects carry are removed.
    - **B1 (Württemberg long form):** bids end "Bittend also:". Collects end "through our Lord Jesus Christ. Amen." wherever they carry a mediation formula or lack a closing Amen.

- **L (Brandenburg):** collects end "through thy Son Jesus Christ. Amen.", in place of the abbreviation "through our Lord etc.".

The other families' texts are continuous prayers or exhortations whose openings and endings are already consistent.

5. **Divergent texts.** Where no reading has half the witnesses, the parent's reading stands. The parent is the earliest witness: the archetype, or, for an added petition, the earliest witness that has it. The same applies when no petition, or no group of related texts, has half the witnesses.

The English is not voted on separately. Each English variation takes the reading of the witnesses whose reading the original chose at the same place. Where only the English varies, as when two translations render the same words, the parent's English is kept. The original and the English therefore give the same text. Sehling's editorial brackets are removed.

What the comparison shows

- **Civil authority is the one universal intention.** It appears in all 57 orders, and in some it is prayed for twice. The Lüneburg family (J) has one petition for the Emperor and all magistrates, and another for the princess of the land and the young lordship.
- **The Church, then the magistrates, is the normal Lutheran sequence.** It comes from Brenz 1526 through Württemberg 1553, and so reaches roughly half the orders. The typical series is: exhortation > the Church > magistrates > the afflicted > peace > enemies > women with child > fruits of the earth > the Our Father. The Reformed Heidelberg prayer begins elsewhere: confession > thanksgiving > the Word > magistrates > all men > the persecuted > the afflicted. Its petition for **all men** (1 Tim. 2) is a Reformed and Upper German feature. It occurs only in Heidelberg (R1, with the Lutheran Schaumburg 1614, which borrows the Heidelberg prayer), in Calvin (R3) and in Augsburg 1537 (Moderate Reformed).
- **The Word and its fruit is named in almost every family except the Brenz and Württemberg line.** There it is folded into the petition for the Church, and only two witnesses of that line add it: Pfalz-Veldenz 1574 (long form) and Magdeburg 1562. It opens the prayer in the Nürnberg exhortation (D), in Bugenhagen and Osnabrück (H), in the Lower Saxon *notel* (J) and in Heidelberg (R1, R2; Reformed).
- **Women with child are prayed for almost everywhere.** They are named in 42 of the 57 orders: in a petition of their own in the Brenz and Württemberg long forms, and within the petition for the afflicted in the short form and most other families. They are absent from the Mass intercessions (L); from Calvin, à Lasco and the Heidelberg paraphrase (all Reformed); from Veit Dietrich's exhortation (Nürnberg 1545 and Waldeck 1556); and from Osnabrück, Magdeburg, Leipzig, Hessen (Moderate Reformed), Worms and Norden (Reformed).
- **Brandenburg 1540 and its followers (family L) put the intercessions in the Mass, under the Sanctus.** These are collects for the ministers, the magistrates and peace, standing where the Roman Canon had its prayers of intercession (Sehling's note on Pfalz-Neuburg 1543). They are the closest evangelical survival of the Canon's intercessions in the corpus.
- **The Württemberg short form is the most copied prayer in the corpus.** Its 17 witnesses run from 1553 to 1618 and reach Electoral Saxony (1580), Magdeburg, Strasbourg and the Wetterau counts. Their local changes include the name of the ruling house, heretics among the enemies, the fallen-away and daily bread.

Conventions

These conventions hold throughout the book.

Citations and references

- **Sehling.** Citations are in the form "Sehling volume, page", for example "(Sehling 8, p. 245)". The half-volumes of the edition are written 6/1, 6/2, 7/1, 7/2.1, 7/2.2, 17/1, 17/2, 19/1, 19/2, 20/1 and 20/2, following the digitized volumes. Where a passage comes from the editor's introduction, notes or apparatus rather than from the text of an order, this is said.
- **Orders** are named by place, title and date as Sehling's running heads give them, for example "**Hessen, *Kirchenordnung*, 1566**". These names sometimes differ from the headings of the records in `eko.db` (Introduction; see, for example, §8.2.3).
- **Doc** in the tables and concordances is the number of the record in `eko.db` that holds the page cited (Introduction). Each quotation is preceded by a note, invisible in print, that names the record it was checked against.
- **Sections** are numbered within their chapter, with the chapter number first: §2.3.2 is section 3.2 of Chapter 2. Appendices are lettered: Appendix 4.A has the sections 4.A.1, 4.A.2 and so on. In Chapter 6 the petitions of each family keep the

family's own numbering (A.1, B1.13) under the numbered family sections. Every reference to a section or a chapter is a link.

- **Concordances.** Each chapter ends with a concordance of the orders it quotes or cites. Its "§" or "Quoted in §" column gives the sections where each order is cited, and each number is a link. In Chapters 4 and 5, "A" in that column means the chapter's appendix.

Quotations

- **This edition gives the quotations in English.** The full edition, `LITURGICAL_AND_ECCLESIASTICAL_LIFE.md`, prints each quotation from the orders in its own language, German, Latin, Low German or Low Dutch, as it stands in `eko.db`, the database built from the digitized edition (Introduction), and follows it with an English translation. Here the original is left out, and the translation follows the citation of the order. Shorter quotations in the running text are given in English as well.
- **Terms and titles.** A term that the book keeps in its original language, such as the name of a liturgical text or of an office, is followed by its English the first time it occurs in a section. The titles of orders and of other works are left as Sehling prints them, so that they can be found in his edition.
- **Square brackets** in a translation enclose words supplied in English to complete the sense, and the signs of Sehling's editors, such as "[!]" and "[sic]", and the Scripture references they supply. A reference that the editors supplied inside a quotation is kept in its English.
- **Omissions.** "[…]" marks an omission. In Chapter 7 it also stands for a hymn or lesson that the order prints in full, or for text given in another section.
- **Checking.** Every quotation from the corpus was checked against the database text before it was translated, allowing for OCR noise: at least 90 per cent of its words must be found there in order. Its page has been checked against the edition's page markers.
- **The Canon texts (Chapter 7)** are translated from Sehling's base text. A cross (✠) marks where the print has a sign of the cross over the elements, and rubrics are in italics. They are compared with the standard text of the late-medieval and Tridentine Roman Mass, given here in English. The diocesan missals of the 1520s–40s differ in small details. Where a German text follows a wording that the Tridentine missal does not have, this is noted, but the wording is not attributed to a particular missal.
- **The general-prayer texts (Chapter 6)** are translated from Sehling's text with his apparatus removed. "N." stands where the order leaves a name to be filled in, and "etc." where it gives only the opening of a well-known text, such as the Our Father or the Creed. Each petition is given as its **rubric** (a heading or direction printed with it), its **bid** (the words addressed to the people, "Let us pray for …") and its **prayer** (the words addressed to God). The **witnesses** are the orders that carry a family's text, named by place and year as in the workbook (Introduction).
- **Texts from outside Sehling.** Where a German collect renders a prayer of the Missal (Chapter 5), the Missal's prayer is cited from the Roman Missal of the period. The Latin tropes of the *Kyrie fons bonitatis* and the *Kyrie magnae Deus potentiae*, which the orders name but do not print, are translated in §8.6.4.7 from *Analecta Hymnica Medii Aevi* 47 (1905). Where Sehling's editors identify the source, this is said, and where the identification is this book's own, that is said too. The English of the Common Service and the later American Lutheran books, given in §3.4.5 for comparison, has not been checked against the corpus.

Translations

- The English is formal-equivalence, in the idiom of the Authorized Version (thee and thou, -eth). Word order and clause structure are kept where English allows, and nothing is smoothed away. Words the translation supplies are in square brackets.
- Liturgical names keep their customary Latin or English forms: Kyrie, Gloria, *Et in terra*, *Patrem*, Sanctus, *Benedicamus*, Matins, Lauds, Prime, Vespers, *Benedictus*, *Magnificat*, *Te Deum*, the Our Father. Stock liturgical phrases are given in their familiar English: *Vere dignum et iustum est* is "It is very meet and right", and *Oremus* and "Last uns bitten" are "Let us pray". Scripture quoted in a prayer is given in the wording of the Authorized Version where the German follows the same text.
- Book titles are given in their usual English form ("the Augsburg Confession", "the Smalcald Articles"). *Corpus doctrinae* and *norma doctrinae* are left in Latin.
- Hymn incipits are translated literally and put in quotation marks, so that the reader can see what the words say. They are not given under the titles of the English hymnals. Thus "Nun bitten wir den heiligen Geist" is "Now pray we the Holy Ghost", and "Erhalt uns, Herr, bei deinem Wort" is "Keep us, Lord, by thy word". In the running text the German incipit is used, and in this edition its English follows it the first time it occurs in a section.

- Stock terms are rendered the same way throughout:

Original	English
Absolution	absolution
Alba	alb
Amt, *ampt*	the office (the communion service)
Amtmann	officer
Aposteltage	apostles' days
aufbieten, *proclamieren*	proclaim (the banns)
Bann	ban
Beicht	confession
Beiern	chime (striking the hanging bell with its clapper, not swinging it)
Bekenntnis	confession
bestätigen, *bestetigen*	confirm
Bild, *imago*	image
Borkirche	gallery
Chorkappe, *Chormantel*, *cappa*	cope
Chorrock, *Chorhemd*, *superpellicium*	surplice
copulieren, *einsegnen*	marry, bless
Diacon, *diaken*	deacon
Diener des Worts	minister of the word
einsetzen	set in office
Eltesten, *seniores*	elders
Fasten, *vasten*	Lent, when it names the season; fasting otherwise
Feiertag, *vyrdach*	holy day
feiern, *vyren*	keep holy (a day)
Fest	feast
figurieren, *in mensuris*	figured music, measured music
fürnembste Feste	chiefest feasts
geloben	vow
Gemälde, *pictura*	painting
gemeine Feste	common feasts
Gesetz, *Vers*, *Versch*	stanza, verse
Gesinde	servants
Glöcklein, *Schelle*, *campanula*	little bell, handbell
Hauptfeste	chief feasts
Hausvater	householder

Original	English
Historie	history
hohe Feste	high feasts
Kirchendiener	minister of the church
Kirchenpfleger	churchwarden
Küster, *Köster*, *Kirchner*, *Custos*, *Mesner*, *Opfermann*, *opperman*	sexton (sometimes "custos")
Leise	kept as *Leise*
Leuten	ring
Lied, *Gesang*, *Lobgesang*	song, song of praise
Meßgewand, *Casel*, *casula*	Mass vestment, chasuble
mit handgebender Treue	with fealty given by the hand
ordinieren	ordain
Orgel schlagen, *orgeln*, *up der orgel spelen*	play [on] the organ
Ornat, *ornatus*	ornaments
Pfarrer, *Pfarrherr*	pastor
Predigtstuhl, *Kanzel*	pulpit
Psalm, *deutscher Psalm*	psalm, German psalm (any metrical hymn, not only a psalm paraphrase)
Puls	pulse (a single spell of ringing)
Quatember, *Fronfasten*	the Ember days
Sakramentshäuslein	sacrament house
Schulmeister	schoolmaster
schwören	swear
Stuhl (in a church)	pew
Superattendent, *Superintendent*	superintendent
Tafel	panel (the painted altarpiece)
Taufe	baptism
Taufstein	font
Tüchlein	little cloth
unterschreiben, *subscribieren*	subscribe
Verhör, *examen*	examination
verlegen	remove, lay over
Vermanung	exhortation
Verstand	sense, understanding
Vierzeiten, *veer tide*	the four times

Original	English
weihen	hallow
Zeichen	sign

Traditions and the Interim

Most of the orders cited are Lutheran, and they are not marked. Every order of another tradition is marked where it is cited, by its name in brackets after the order, as "Kurpfalz 1563 (Reformed)" or "Hesse 1566 (Moderate Reformed)". Orders made under or for the Augsburg Interim of 1548 are marked as Interim orders. The traditions and the Interim orders are those of the inventory in Chapter 1 (§1.3, §1.4):

- **Reformed**: the Swiss, Calvinist and Heidelberg churches, among them the German territories that turned Reformed after 1560 and the French and Dutch stranger churches;
- **Moderate Reformed**: the Bucerian and related orders that stood between the Lutheran and the Swiss Reformed: Bucer's Strasbourg and the Upper German cities before the Interim, Philip of Hesse's church to 1566, Hermann von Wied's Cologne order, Rothmann's Münster, East Frisia under John a Lasco, and Colmar after 1578;
- **Philippist**: the churches that held to Melanchthon's later teaching and his *Corpus doctrinae* and refused the Formula of Concord: the joint Hessian synods and orders of 1568–1598, Bremen 1556–1575, Nassau-Dillenburg 1575 and Anhalt 1590–1594;
- **Anglican**: the English exile congregation at Frankfurt;
- **Bohemian Brethren** (Hussite): the Unity of the Brethren in Greater Poland;
- **Sandomierz consensus**: the Polish synods at which Lutherans, Reformed and Brethren met together;
- **Roman Catholic humanist**: the Erasmian orders of Jülich-Cleves-Berg, which reform the old church without leaving it;
- **Roman Catholic**: the Bishop of Münster's edict of 1534 against the Anabaptists;
- **Radical Reformation**: Thomas Müntzer's Allstedt orders;
- **Anabaptist**: the Münster council's mandate of January 1534, which tolerated the Anabaptists;
- **Reformed–Lutheran treaty**: the East Frisian settlements of 1595 and 1599;
- **Multi-confessional**: the decrees of the Transylvanian diets, which received the Catholic, Lutheran, Reformed and Unitarian religions side by side. The Transylvanian Saxons' own orders, chapters and synods are Lutheran.

The mark follows the order cited, not the territory, since a territory could change its tradition:

- Strasbourg is Moderate Reformed until the Interim of 1548 and Lutheran after it. Its German Masses of 1524–1525 are Moderate Reformed, and Marbach's order of 1553 is Lutheran.
- Kurpfalz is Lutheran in 1546 and 1556 and under Ludwig VI (1576–1583), and Reformed in 1563–1576 and from 1583. Johann Casimir's Pfalz-Lautern stayed Reformed under Ludwig VI.
- Hesse is Moderate Reformed under Philip (to 1566) and Philippist under his sons. After the division, Hessen-Kassel turned Reformed (1605) and Hessen-Darmstadt stayed Lutheran.
- Bremen is Philippist from 1556 to 1575 and Reformed from 1582.
- Nassau-Dillenburg is Lutheran to 1570, Philippist in 1575 and Reformed from 1581.
- Anhalt is Philippist in 1590–1594 and Reformed from 1596.
- Pfalz-Zweibrücken is Lutheran until 1588, and Pfalz-Simmern until it fell to the Electoral Palatinate in 1598.

Where an order could be counted either Moderate Reformed or Philippist, it is counted Moderate Reformed. Some further distinctions:

- "Philippist" also names a party within the Lutheran churches, as in Electoral Saxony before 1574. An order is marked " (Philippist)" only where the inventory counts it so.
- The family names of the Mass in Chapter 2 (§2.4) are names of liturgical shape. "Upper German" there means the south-western Lutheran service of Württemberg and its copies, not the Moderate Reformed Upper German Reformation of Bucer's circle.
- The orders that took over Müntzer's German propers (Erfurt 1525, Calenberg-Göttingen 1542, Lippe 1571) are Lutheran. Only Müntzer's own Allstedt orders are marked.
- Some Lutheran orders took the Reformed line on images, vestments or vessels: Lichtenberg 1579, Sponheim 1590/91, the Upper Palatine visitation of 1579 and Nassau-Weilburg 1617. They are Lutheran orders, and the text says where they agree

with the Reformed.
- Swiss sources outside the corpus (Zürich 1525, Basel 1526, Geneva) are Reformed.

Abbreviations

- **Confessional writings** (Chapter 17 and elsewhere): CA = the Augsburg Confession (1530); CA *variata* = Melanchthon's altered edition of 1540; Apol = the Apology of the Augsburg Confession; SA = the Smalcald Articles; SC and LC = Luther's Small and Large Catechisms; FC = the Formula of Concord (1577); BoC = the Book of Concord (1580); *CPhil* = the *Corpus doctrinae Philippicum* (1560); KO = *Kirchenordnung*, church order.
- **The parts of the Mass**, in the tables of Chapter 2: Intr. (the introit, or the hymn in its place), Ky. (Kyrie), Gl. (Gloria), Coll. (collect), Ep. (epistle), Grad. (gradual, alleluia, sequence, or the hymn after the epistle), Gosp. (gospel), Cr. (creed), Serm. (sermon), Exh. (exhortation to the communicants), Pref. (Preface), San. (Sanctus), PN (Lord's Prayer), Verba (Words of Institution), Agn. (Agnus Dei), Comm. (distribution), Thanks. (postcommunion collect or thanksgiving), Bl. (blessing). Brackets mark a part that the order allows but does not require, and "→" separates the parts.
- **Traditions**, in the tables of Chapter 1: L = Lutheran; R = Reformed; MR = Moderate Reformed (Bucerian and Upper German); PH = Philippist; A = Anglican; H = Hussite (Unity of the Bohemian Brethren); C = Sandomierz consensus (Lutheran, Reformed and Brethren together); R/L = Reformed and Lutheran (treaty between the two); RCH = Roman Catholic humanist (Erasmian reform); RC = Roman Catholic; RAD = Radical Reformation (Müntzer); ANA = Anabaptist (civic toleration of the Anabaptists); T = multi-confessional diet decree (Catholic, Lutheran, Reformed and Unitarian received side by side).

The inventory tables of Chapter 1

- **No.** is the number Sehling, or the later editor, gives the text within its territory. Volumes 1–5 number their registers in their own way, and their numbers are given as they stand.
- **Order** is the title as Sehling's tables of contents give it. For volumes 1–5 the titles come from the chronological register at the end of each volume. Long titles are shortened, and "…" marks the cut. Spelling is as printed, including OCR errors.
- **Date** is the year in the title or in the register. A few undated texts are dated from the text or from the editor's introduction or notes, as the notes column says. "n.d." means no single year is known.
- **Sehling** gives the volume and the page where the text begins. For volume 14 it is sometimes the introduction page where Sehling only describes the order.
- **Doc** is the record in `eko.db` that holds that page (Introduction).
- **Kind** is assigned from the words of the title (§1.2.4).
- **Trad.** gives the tradition, in the codes listed under Abbreviations.
- **Interim / notes** marks the Interim orders and texts tied to the Interim (§1.4), and adds notes such as the reigning prince.

Chapter 1. The Church Orders: An Inventory by Tradition

This chapter lists every order that Sehling's *Die evangelischen Kirchenordnungen des XVI. Jahrhunderts* (The Evangelical Church Orders of the Sixteenth Century) prints, volume by volume and territory by territory: 2,581 texts in 24 volumes (30 parts). For each order it gives:

- its number in Sehling, its title, and its date;
- the page in Sehling and the `eko.db` document that holds the text;
- what kind of order it is (church order, agenda, visitation order, mandate, and so on);
- the confessional tradition it belongs to: Lutheran, Reformed, Moderate Reformed (Bucer's circle and the Upper German cities), Philippist, Anglican, Hussite, and a few others;
- whether it is an Interim order, or otherwise tied to the Augsburg Interim of 1548.

Confessional traditions and Interim orders

Sehling's title calls these the *evangelical* church orders, and most of them are Lutheran: 1,950 of the 2,581 texts. The rest belong to other traditions:

- **Reformed** (340): the Swiss, Calvinist and Heidelberg churches, among them the German territories that turned Reformed after 1560 and the French and Dutch stranger churches;
- **Moderate Reformed** (198): the Bucerian and related orders that stood between the Lutheran and the Swiss Reformed: Bucer's Strasbourg and the Upper German cities before the Interim, Philip of Hesse's church to 1566, Hermann von Wied's Cologne order, Rothmann's Münster, East Frisia under John a Lasco, and Colmar after 1578;
- **Philippist** (33): the churches that held to Melanchthon's later teaching and his *Corpus doctrinae* (body of doctrine) and refused the Formula of Concord: the joint Hessian synods and orders of 1568-1598, Bremen 1556-1575, Nassau-Dillenburg 1575 and Anhalt 1590-1594;
- a few others: Anglican (the English exile congregation at Frankfurt), the Bohemian Brethren (Hussite), the Sandomierz consensus of Lutherans, Reformed and Brethren in Poland, the Roman Catholic humanist orders of Jülich-Cleves-Berg, Thomas Müntzer's orders (Radical Reformation), one Roman Catholic and one Anabaptist-toleration text from Münster, two Reformed-Lutheran treaties in East Frisia, and the multi-confessional Transylvanian diet decrees.

A territory's tradition can change from one order to the next: Kurpfalz is Lutheran in 1556 and Reformed in 1563, and Strasbourg Moderate Reformed before the Interim of 1548 and Lutheran after it. This chapter gives the tradition of every order (§1.3 defines them). Where an order could be counted either Moderate Reformed or Philippist, it is counted Moderate Reformed. The chapter also lists the few Interim orders and the texts tied to the Augsburg Interim (§1.4).

The other chapters mark every order of another tradition, and every Interim order, where they cite it (Conventions).

Layout

- §1.1 summarizes the findings.
- §1.2 sets out the scope, the method and the cautions.
- §1.3 defines the traditions and says where each is found.
- §1.4 lists the Interim orders and the other texts tied to the Interim.
- §1.5 is a table of the territories at a glance.
- §§1.6-1.35 are the inventory itself, one section per volume. Each territory has a short note on its confessional history, followed by a table of its orders.

The columns of the inventory tables and the codes for the traditions are explained in the Conventions.

1.1 Summary of findings

1. The set holds 2,581 orders. Sehling took "church order" in the widest sense (§1.2.1). The set therefore includes far more than the great church orders and agendas:

Kind	Texts
Church order	333
Agenda / liturgy	271
Visitation	346
Mandate / decree	436
Consistory / synod / government	265
Discipline / police	178
Marriage	90
Poor relief	82
School / university	65
Catechism / instruction	44
Monastery / chapter	46
Appointment / oath	59
Treaty / agreement	77
Articles / statutes	45
Local order	59
Confession / doctrine	31
Property / endowment	6
Other	148

The full church orders (**333**) and the agendas and other liturgical orders (**271**) together make up about a quarter of the set. Many of the rest are visitation orders, mandates, consistory and synod orders, and orders on marriage, discipline, schools and the poor.

2. Most of the orders are Lutheran. By tradition:

Tradition	Code	Texts
Lutheran	L	1950
Reformed	R	340
Moderate Reformed (Bucerian and Upper German)	MR	198
Philippist	PH	33
Anglican	A	1
Hussite (Unity of the Bohemian Brethren)	H	3
Sandomierz consensus (Lutheran, Reformed and Brethren together)	C	6
Reformed and Lutheran (treaty between the two)	R/L	2
Roman Catholic humanist (Erasmian reform)	RCH	18
Roman Catholic	RC	1
Radical Reformation (Müntzer)	RAD	3
Anabaptist (civic toleration of the Anabaptists)	ANA	1

Tradition	Code	Texts
Multi-confessional diet decree (Catholic, Lutheran, Reformed and Unitarian received side by side)	T	25

- **Lutheran** (1,950): Saxony, Brandenburg, Prussia, Pomerania, the Baltic, Mecklenburg, the Hanse towns, Lower Saxony, Franconia, Württemberg, Hohenlohe and most of the imperial cities after 1552.
- **Reformed** (340): above all the Electoral Palatinate (from 1561/63) and the "Second Reformation" counties of the Wetterau and the Rhine (Nassau-Dillenburg, Hanau-Münzenberg, Ysenburg, Solms-Braunfels, Sayn, Wied, Wittgenstein, Moers, Bentheim-Tecklenburg), Pfalz-Zweibrücken (1588), Pfalz-Simmern (1598, under the Electoral Palatinate), Hessen-Kassel (1600/1605), Lippe (1600), Anhalt (1596), Bremen (from 1580), Emden and the East Frisian Reformed congregations, the London Dutch church, Mülhausen (Mulhouse), and the French refugee churches of Frankfurt, Wetzlar and the Lebertal.
- **Moderate Reformed** (198): Bucer's Strasbourg and the Upper German cities before the Interim (Konstanz, Ulm, Esslingen, Augsburg, Memmingen, Lindau, Isny, Biberach, Gengenbach, Landau, Worms, early Frankfurt); Philip's Hesse to 1566; Hermann von Wied's Cologne Reformation (1543-1546); Rothmann's Münster (1532/33); East Frisia under Countess Anna; Colmar after 1578, whose pastors came from Basel.
- **Philippist** (33): the joint Hessian synods and orders of 1568-1582 and the Hessian orders that followed them to 1598; Bremen (1556-1575); Nassau-Dillenburg (1575); Anhalt (1590-1594).
- **Anglican** (1): the order of the English exile congregation at Frankfurt, the "Old Discipline" and "New Discipline" of 1557 (§1.3.4).
- **Hussite** (3): the order of the Unity of the Bohemian Brethren (synod of Zerawitz, 1616) and the privileges for the Brethren's congregations at Ostroróg (1569) and Lissa (1580), in Greater Poland (§1.3.5). Six more Polish texts belong to the **Sandomierz consensus** of 1570, in which Lutherans, Reformed and Brethren joined.
- **Others**, each labelled with its own affiliation (§1.3.6):
  - **Roman Catholic humanist (Erasmian)** (18): the church orders of Jülich-Cleves-Berg;
  - **Roman Catholic** (1): the Bishop of Münster's edict against the Anabaptists (1534);
  - **Radical Reformation** (3): Thomas Müntzer's Allstedt orders;
  - **Anabaptist** (1): the Münster council's mandate of January 1534 that let each keep his faith and so recognized the Anabaptists;
  - **Multi-confessional** (25): the decrees of the Transylvanian diets;
  - **Reformed and Lutheran** (2): two East Frisian treaties between the Lutheran count and Reformed Emden.
- **Not in the set**: no order of the Waldensians, Lollards, Utraquists, Schwenckfelders, Hutterites, Mennonites or Antitrinitarians. Anabaptists, Schwenckfelders, Davidjorists, Mennonites and "Sakramentierer" appear only as the targets of some thirty mandates, which are coded by the authority that issued them.

3. Almost no Interim orders. Sehling deliberately left out the orders made under the Augsburg Interim of 1548 (§1.2.2). Only four Interim orders proper are in the set (§1.4):

- the Brandenburg-Ansbach "Mehrung der vorigen kirchenordnung" ("augmentation of the former church order", the "Auctuarium") of 1548, printed "because of its special importance";
- the East Frisian Interim order of 16 July 1549, printed in the editor's introduction;
- the Württemberg Interim mandate of 1548;
- the Biberach council's mandate after accepting the Interim (1548).

16 further texts are tied to the Interim in other ways: issued under it, about it, or ending it (§1.4).

4. Tradition followed the ruler, and changed with him. Many territories changed tradition within the century, and their orders change with them:

- **Electoral Palatinate**: Lutheran → Reformed (1561/63) → Lutheran (1577) → Reformed (1583).
- **Upper Palatinate**: Lutheran → Reformed (1559) → Lutheran (1577) → Reformed (1583).
- **Nassau-Dillenburg**: Lutheran → Philippist (1573) → Reformed (1578).
- **Bremen**: Lutheran → Philippist (1562) → Reformed (1580).
- **Hanau-Münzenberg** (1595), **Sayn** (1605), **Lippe** (1600), **Pfalz-Zweibrücken** (1588), **Wittgenstein** (about 1574), **Moers** (1578) and **Bentheim-Tecklenburg** (1580s): Lutheran → Reformed.
- **Ysenburg**: Ronneburg-Kelsterbach was Reformed 1584-1597, then Lutheran again; Birstein became Reformed in 1596.
- **The Upper German cities**: Upper German before the Interim, Lutheran afterwards.

1.2 Scope, sources and cautions

1.2.1 What Sehling counted as a church order

Sehling took the term in its widest sense, to cover every ordinance that regulated church affairs. **Sehling, preface to vol. 1, 1902** (Sehling 1, p. VIII):

We therefore take the term "church order" for our collection in the widest sense of the word, and understand by it all ordinances made for the regulation of church affairs (excepting, of course, those orders that served merely passing and particular ends).

1.2.2 What he left out: half measures and the Interim

Sehling also excluded orders that were never in force, and the "half measures" of wavering rulers. **Sehling, preface to vol. 1, 1902** (Sehling 1, p. XV):

Furthermore, only the truly evangelical church orders will be given. Excepted are the half measures that wavering authorities made to calm men's minds, or perhaps in an effort to bring in reforms, without their ever becoming truly evangelical orders. In particular I do not intend to print the Interim church orders.

He held to this for Saxony, where the great Interim agenda of 1549 is only described. **Sehling, introduction to Albertine Saxony** (Sehling 1, p. 102):

The period of the Interim is only touched on in our collection, and so the great order that falls in that period is not treated further here either: a product of necessity and of yielding, it cannot be called a purely evangelical order.

His successors kept the rule, with one deliberate exception. **Brandenburg-Ansbach-Kulmbach, editor's introduction** (Sehling 11, p. 291):

Although Interim orders are in general not to be taken into this edition, this one is nevertheless printed as no. IV 4 because of its special importance.

Later volumes also print Reformed, Erasmian and multi-confessional orders: the Reformed Palatinate and the Wetterau counties, the Jülich orders, the Transylvanian diets. The inventory follows the volumes as they stand.

1.2.3 How the list was made

- **The list of texts.** It is taken from each volume's own table of contents (volumes 6-24) or chronological register (volumes 1-5).
  - Where the scanned contents page is unusable, the titles were read from the running heads of the texts. This applies to Oldenburg and Jever in vol. 7/2.1.
  - The registers of volumes 1-5 list orders printed "ganz oder theilweise", in whole or in part. They therefore include some orders printed only in extract within an introduction.
  - Volume 14 (Kurpfalz) lists, among its texts, some orders that Sehling only describes in his introduction. These are marked "described in the introduction only".
  - Introductions, registers and editorial chapters are left out.
- **Tradition.** It is assigned by territory and date, following the editors' introductions. Each territory's note in §§1.6-1.35 gives its confessional history and the dates of change; each order takes the tradition of its territory at its date. Where an order belongs to a group with another tradition, it is marked individually. Examples:
  - a refugee congregation in a Lutheran city;
  - Hessen-Darmstadt orders within divided Hesse;
  - Solms-Braunfels within Solms;
  - the Lemgo recess of 1617, which guaranteed the town's Lutheran confession within Reformed Lippe.
- **Interim.** Texts are marked from their titles and from the editors' introductions (§1.4).

1.2.4 Kinds

The **Kind** column sorts the orders by the main word of the title. The kinds are:

- *Church order*: Kirchenordnung (church order), Agenda das ist Kirchenordnung (agenda, that is, church order), Reformation, ordinatio (ordinance);
- *Agenda / liturgy*: Agende (agenda), Messe (Mass), Gottesdienst (divine service), Taufe (baptism), Trauung (wedding), Abendmahl (Supper), Gesang (song), Gebet (prayer), Litanei (litany), Vesper (Vespers), Beichte (confession), Busse (penance), Ordination;
- *Visitation*: visitation orders and recesses, general articles;
- *Consistory / synod / government*: consistory, synod, church council, superintendent, classis, presbytery, ministerium, church officers;
- *Marriage*, *School / university*, *Poor relief*, *Monastery / chapter*, *Appointment / oath*, *Confession / doctrine*, *Catechism / instruction*, *Treaty / agreement*, *Property / endowment*;
- *Articles / statutes*: articles, instructions, leges (laws), statutes;
- *Discipline / police*: Zucht (discipline), Polizei (police), Sonntag (Sunday), Feiertag (holy day), Täufer (Anabaptists), Landordnung (territorial order);
- *Mandate / decree*: Mandat (mandate), Edikt (edict), Befehl (command), Ausschreiben (circular), Verordnung (ordinance);
- *Local order*: an "Ordnung für" ("order for") a town or village without further description;
- *Other*.

Large church orders contain agendas, catechisms and much else besides. The Kind column gives only the leading character of the title. Search the text in `eko.db` for the parts of a large order.

1.2.5 Cautions

- **Coding by territory.** The tradition codes follow the territory and its ruler. They do not judge each text's theology; a Lutheran territory's marriage or poor-law order is coded L.
- **Moderate Reformed and Philippist.** The orders that stood between the Lutheran and the Reformed are divided into two groups (§1.3.3):
    - **Moderate Reformed**: Bucer's Strasbourg and the Upper German Zwinglian-Bucerian cities; Philip of Hesse's church, which stood within the Wittenberg Concord but bore Bucer's stamp; Hermann von Wied's Cologne order; and the other orders of Bucer's sphere;
    - **Philippist**: the churches that held to Melanchthon's later teaching and his *Corpus doctrinae* (body of doctrine) and would not accept the Formula of Concord: the joint Hessian synods, Bremen, Nassau-Dillenburg and Anhalt, each on its way to the Reformed.

    Where an order could be placed in either group, it is counted as Moderate Reformed. Use the territory notes for the finer distinctions.
- **Early orders** (1522-1530) come before the confessional lines were fixed. They are coded by what the territory became; Müntzer's orders are coded as radical.
- **Pages and dates.** Some come from OCR of contents pages and registers. Where a register's page was plainly wrong, it was checked against the text; a few may still be out by a page or two.
- **Doc** is the `eko.db` document holding the start page. One database record may hold several orders, and one order may run over several records.

1.3 The traditions

1.3.1 Lutheran (L)

Orders of territories and cities that held to the Augsburg Confession in its Lutheran reading, from the Wittenberg orders of the 1520s to the Formula of Concord and after. 1,950 texts. Volumes 3, 5, 6/1, 6/2, 7/2.1, 11, 15, 16 and 23 are wholly Lutheran, and volume 1 is too, save Müntzer's three orders. Lutheran orders are a minority only in volumes 8 (Hesse, coded Moderate Reformed and Philippist), 10 (Nassau, Hanau, Ysenburg), 14 and 19/2 (Kurpfalz), 20/1 (Strasbourg) and 20/2 (Alsace).

1.3.2 Reformed (R)

Orders of churches that took the Reformed (Swiss, Calvinist or Heidelberg) confession. Most belong to the "Second Reformation" of German territories that turned from Lutheran to Reformed after 1560. The rest are refugee and stranger churches (French, Dutch, Walloon) and the Swiss-allied city of Mülhausen.

- Principality of Anhalt (Sehling 2, §1.7): 3 texts, 1596-1599.
- Greater Poland (Posen): synods, the Bohemian Brethren and the towns (Sehling 4, §1.9): 3 texts, 1560-1561.
- East Frisia: Reformed orders of limited range (Norden, Emden, Leer, Lütetsburg; London) (Sehling 7/1, §1.13): 15 texts, 1528-1606.
- City of Bremen (Sehling 7/2.2, §1.15): 13 texts, 1582-1616.
- Divided Hesse (1582-1618) (Sehling 9, §1.17): 11 texts, 1600-1618.
- County of Solms (Sehling 9, §1.17): 7 texts, 1582-1616.
- Imperial city of Frankfurt (Sehling 9, §1.17): 2 texts, 1554-1585.
- Imperial city of Wetzlar (Sehling 9, §1.17): 2 texts, 1586-1596.
- Nassau-Dillenburg (Sehling 10, §1.18): 14 texts, 1581-1618.
- County of Hanau-Münzenberg (Sehling 10, §1.18): 24 texts, 1596-1614.
- County of Ysenburg (Sehling 10, §1.18): 12 texts, 1580-1614.
- Upper Palatinate (Electoral Palatinate) (Sehling 13, §1.21): 13 texts, 1566-1615.
- Electoral Palatinate (Kurpfalz) (Sehling 14, §1.22): 67 texts, 1561-1615.
- Duchy of Pfalz-Zweibrücken (Sehling 18, §1.27): 13 texts, 1588-1617.
- County of Sayn (Sehling 19/1, §1.28): 3 texts, 1606-1619.
- County of Wied (Sehling 19/1, §1.28): 8 texts, 1564-1619.
- Electoral Palatinate (supplement to vol. 14) (Sehling 19/2, §1.29): 65 texts, 1577-1610.
- Principality of Pfalz-Simmern (Sehling 19/2, §1.29): 2 texts, 1598.
- Lordship of Rappoltstein (Sehling 20/2, §1.31): 10 texts, 1558-1569.
- Imperial city of Mülhausen (Mulhouse) (Sehling 20/2, §1.31): 27 texts, 1523-1582.
- County of Lippe (Sehling 21, §1.32): 1 text, 1600.
- Archbishopric of Cologne (Sehling 22, §1.33): 2 texts, 1583.
- County of Wittgenstein (Sehling 22, §1.33): 10 texts, 1579-1611.
- County of Moers (Sehling 22, §1.33): 3 texts, 1581-1603.
- County of Bentheim-Tecklenburg (Sehling 22, §1.33): 10 texts, 1601-1619.

1.3.3 Moderate Reformed (MR) and Philippist (PH)

Between the Lutheran and the Swiss Reformed stood two groups of orders. They are coded apart, and where an order could belong to either, it is counted as Moderate Reformed.

Moderate Reformed (MR), 198 texts: the Bucerian and Upper German orders, and others close to them:

- the Upper German Reformation of Bucer, Capito, Blarer and Zwick in the southern imperial cities before the Interim;
- Philip of Hesse's church, which bore Bucer's stamp. Bucer had a decisive share in the orders of 1539, and Philip's testament gave the Wittenberg Concord, Bucer's work, almost confessional weight. The editors place the Kirchenordnung of 1566 in the Strasbourg sphere;
- Hermann von Wied's Cologne order (written by Bucer and Melanchthon);
- a few early evangelical orders that moved toward Zurich (Rothmann's Münster) or took their pastors from Basel and ended Reformed (Colmar after 1578), and East Frisia under Countess Anna and John a Lasco.
- East Frisia: comital orders (Sehling 7/1, §1.13): 1 text, 1545.
- Landgraviate of Hesse under Philip (to 1567) (Sehling 8, §1.16): 21 texts, 1526-1566.
- Imperial city of Frankfurt (Sehling 9, §1.17): 4 texts, 1530-1533.
- Imperial city of Augsburg (Sehling 12, §1.20): 13 texts, 1523-1548.
- Imperial city of Lindau (Sehling 12, §1.20): 3 texts, 1533-1539.

- Imperial city of Memmingen (Sehling 12, §1.20): 4 texts, 1528-1542.
- Imperial city of Konstanz (Sehling 17/1, §1.25): 19 texts, 1524-1548.
- Imperial city of Isny (Sehling 17/1, §1.25): 2 texts, 1533-1544.
- Imperial city of Gengenbach (Sehling 17/1, §1.25): 8 texts, 1538-1545.
- Imperial city of Ulm (Sehling 17/2, §1.26): 15 texts, 1528-1544.
- Imperial city of Esslingen (Sehling 17/2, §1.26): 34 texts, 1531-1547.
- Imperial city of Biberach an der Riß (Sehling 17/2, §1.26): 3 texts, 1531-1548.
- Imperial city of Landau (Sehling 19/1, §1.28): 5 texts, 1526-1554.
- Imperial city of Worms (Sehling 19/1, §1.28): 3 texts, 1524-1543.
- Imperial city of Strasbourg (Sehling 20/1, §1.30): 46 texts, 1523-1548.
- Imperial city of Colmar (Sehling 20/2, §1.31): 12 texts, 1578-1615.
- Archbishopric of Cologne (Sehling 22, §1.33): 1 text, 1546.
- City of Münster (Sehling 22, §1.33): 4 texts, 1532-1533.

Philippist (PH), 33 texts: churches that held to Melanchthon's later teaching and his *Corpus doctrinae* (body of doctrine) of 1560, and would not accept the Formula of Concord. Most of them later turned Reformed:

- the joint synods of the Hessian landgraviates (1568-1582), which took the Wittenberg *Corpus doctrinae* as their norm, and the Hessian orders that followed to 1598;
- Bremen, from Albert Hardenberg's dispute (1556) to the Reformed turn of 1580;
- Nassau-Dillenburg's Agende of 1575, which binds the pastors to the Augsburg Confession and the *Examen* (examination) of Philip Melanchthon;
- Anhalt under Prince Johann Georg before the Reformed turn of 1596.
- Principality of Anhalt (Sehling 2, §1.7): 2 texts, 1590-1594.
- City of Bremen (Sehling 7/2.2, §1.15): 9 texts, 1556-1575.
- The Hessian landgraviates: joint synods and orders (1567-1582) (Sehling 8, §1.16): 16 texts, 1568-1582.
- Divided Hesse (1582-1618) (Sehling 9, §1.17): 5 texts, 1574-1598.
- Nassau-Dillenburg (Sehling 10, §1.18): 1 text, 1575.

1.3.4 Anglican (A)

One order in the set is Anglican: the "Old Discipline" and "New Discipline" of the English exile congregation at Frankfurt (1557). It was founded in 1554 by Marian exiles under Whittingham and John Knox. In 1555 a second group under Richard Cox, loyal to the Book of Common Prayer, took the lead and drove Knox out. **Frankfurt, editor's introduction** (Sehling 9, p. 492):

Although, after the departure of Knox's faction, the English congregation was thoroughly Anglican in character, the New Discipline shows traits of congregational development within the existing framework of the Second Book of Common Prayer.

- Imperial city of Frankfurt (Sehling 9, §1.17): 1 text, 1557.

Sehling calls the congregation "englisch-reformiert". It is coded A here because the editor shows that its order was framed within the Prayer Book.

Two related orders are coded R:

- the order of John a Lasco's Dutch stranger church in London under Edward VI, in Micron's German abridgement (Sehling 7/1, p. 579);
- the French Reformed congregation's *Liturgia sacra* (Sacred Liturgy) of 1554 at Frankfurt (Sehling 9, p. 562). Frankfurt also required the English congregation to use it.

1.3.5 Hussite: the Bohemian Brethren (H), and the Sandomierz consensus (C)

The Hussite tradition reaches the set through the Unity of the Brethren (Unitas Fratrum) in Greater Poland. **Greater Poland, Sehling's introduction** (Sehling 4, p. 248):

In Poland both the Lutheran and the Reformed teaching spread at the same time. Alongside them arose congregations of the Bohemian Brethren in large numbers.

The Brethren had united with the Little Polish Reformed at Koźminek in 1555. In 1570, at Sandomierz, they joined with the Reformed and the Lutherans in a common Consensus. Sehling prints the Ostroróg privilege because of the town's place in the Unity. **Greater Poland, Sehling's introduction** (Sehling 4, p. 254):

Since Ostroróg was the chief congregation of the Unity and the seat of the senior, this privilege shall be printed from a translation kindly placed at my disposal.

The Brethren (H):

- Greater Poland (Posen): synods, the Bohemian Brethren and the towns (Sehling 4, §1.9): 3 texts, 1569-1616.
  - Kirchenordnung der Böhmischen Brüder (1616; Sehling 4, p. 273).
  - Privileg für Lissa (1580; Sehling 4, p. 298).
  - Privileg für Ostrorog (1569; Sehling 4, p. 299).

The Sandomierz consensus and its general synods (C):

- Synode von Sendomir (1570; Sehling 4, p. 257).
- Synode von Posen (1570; Sehling 4, p. 258).
- Synode von Krakau (1573; Sehling 4, p. 260).
- Synode von Petrikau (1578; Sehling 4, p. 262).
- Synode von Wladislaw (1583; Sehling 4, p. 263).
- Synode von Thorn (1595; Sehling 4, p. 265).

The synods of Xions (1560) and Pińczów (1561) belong to the Little Polish Reformed church united with the Brethren, and are coded R. The Lutheran synod of Gostyń (1565) and the town orders of Fraustadt are coded L.

The Brethren's order of 1616 was adopted by their general synod at Zerawitz in Moravia; Sehling prints it for the Polish congregations. No Utraquist order is in the set.

1.3.6 Others

- **Roman Catholic humanist, Erasmian reform (RCH).** The church orders of Duke Johann III of Jülich-Cleves-Berg (1532/33) and their successors. They reform the old church on humanist lines without leaving it (Sehling 21; §1.32.1).
- **Multi-confessional diet decrees (T).** The decrees of the Transylvanian diets (1552-1619) regulate a principality that received the Lutheran, Reformed, Unitarian and Catholic religions side by side. The Transylvanian Saxons' own orders are Lutheran. The *Consensus doctrinae* of 1557 is also coded L (Sehling 24; §1.35).
- **Radical Reformation (RAD).** Thomas Müntzer's German church office, German evangelical Mass and order of the German service at Allstedt (1523/24). They are coded apart from the Lutheran orders around them in vol. 1.
- **Anabaptist (ANA).** The Münster council and guild masters' mandate of 31 January 1534, three weeks before the Anabaptist council was elected. It bound the citizens to let each keep his faith, and so recognized the Anabaptists as a religious group in the city (Sehling 22, p. 363). It is not an order made by Anabaptists: no Anabaptist church order is in the set.
- **Roman Catholic (RC).** Bishop Franz von Waldeck's edict of 3 February 1534 against the "damned heresy and sect of the Anabaptists" (Sehling 22, p. 364).

- **Groups with no order in the set.** There are no orders of the Waldensians (named only in passing, by Luther and in the editors' notes), the Lollards, the Utraquists, the Schwenckfelders, the Hutterites, the Mennonites or the Antitrinitarians. Mandates against Anabaptists, Schwenckfelders, Davidjorists, Mennonites and "Sakramentierer" are coded by the authority that issued them: Lutheran, Reformed, Moderate Reformed or, in Jülich, Roman Catholic humanist.
- **Treaty (R/L).** The East Frisian Delfzijl settlement of 1595 and the Concordats of 1599, between the Lutheran count and Reformed Emden.

1.4 The Interim orders

The Augsburg Interim of 1548 imposed a largely Catholic order on the Protestant estates until a final council, allowing only the chalice and clerical marriage. The Leipzig Interim (1548/49) was Electoral Saxony's milder version. As §1.2.2 shows, Sehling meant to print no Interim orders. Those in the set fall into four groups:

- **Interim order**: an order made to put the Interim into effect, or to adapt a territory's order to it;
- **under the Interim**: a text issued while the Interim was in force, not itself an Interim order;
- **on the Interim**: a text about the Interim, such as a response, a settlement or a protest;
- **after the Interim** or **end of the Interim**: a text that ends or repairs it.

Order	Date	Territory	Sehling	Doc	Interim	Trad.
Ostfriesische Interimsordnung, 16. Juli 1549 (printed in the editor's introduction, n. 51)	1549	East Frisia: comital orders	7/1, p. 328	2105	Interim order	L
Im Auftrag des Rates verfaßte Stellungnahme der Prädikanten zum Interim [14. Juli 1548]	1548	Imperial city of Goslar	7/2.2, p. 290	2199	On the Interim	L
Die „Neue Ordnung“ 25. September 1548	1548	Imperial city of Goslar	7/2.2, p. 293	2200	Interim year (civic order)	L
Mehrung der vorigen kirchenordnung. 1548	1548	Brandenburg-Ansbach-Kulmbach (from 1528/1533)	11, p. 325	277	Interim order	L
Bußvermahnung wegen des Verhaltens während des Interims vom 22. Juni 1552	1552	Imperial city of Regensburg	13, p. 417	439	After the Interim	L
Interimsmandat 1548	1548	Duchy of Württemberg (with Mömpelgard and Horburg)	16, p. 166	661	Interim order	L
Mandat zur Wiederanstellung evangelischer Prediger 1549	1549	Duchy of Württemberg (with Mömpelgard and Horburg)	16, p. 168	662	Under the Interim	L
Kirchenratsmandat 1548	1548	Duchy of Württemberg (with Mömpelgard and Horburg)	16, p. 169	663	Under the Interim	L
Predigtmandat 1550	1550	Duchy of Württemberg (with Mömpelgard and Horburg)	16, p. 197	667	Under the Interim	L
Mandat zur Abschaffung der Messe 1552	1552	Duchy of Württemberg (with Mömpelgard and Horburg)	16, p. 198	668	End of the Interim	L
Täufermandate: Verbot, mit den Täufern Handel zu treiben 1548	1548	Imperial city of Schwäbisch Hall	17/1, p. 195	763	Under the Interim	L

Order	Date	Territory	Sehling	Doc	Interim	Trad.
Statuten des Landkapitels [1553]	1553	Imperial city of Schwäbisch Hall	17/1, p. 197	763	Under the Interim	L
Ratsmandat für die Prediger zur Gewissensfreiheit nach Annahme des Interims [1548]	1548	Imperial city of Biberach an der Riß	17/2, p. 449	907	Interim order	MR
Täufermandat [1549]	1549	Imperial city of Biberach an der Riß	17/2, p. 451	908	Under the Interim	L
Übereinkunft der Geistlichen zu Lehre, Zensur und Gottesdienstgestaltung [Nach 2. Juli] 1548	1548	Imperial city of Strasbourg	20/1, p. 352	1316	On the Interim	MR
Agende für die Taufe und Trauung 27. Juni 1549	1549	Imperial city of Strasbourg	20/1, p. 357	1317	Under the Interim	L
Examensordnung 1549	1549	Imperial city of Strasbourg	20/1, p. 364	1318	Under the Interim	L
Schiedsvertrag zwischen dem Bischof von Straßburg und dem Magistrat der Stadt über die Durchführung …	1549	Imperial city of Strasbourg	20/1, p. 368	1319	Interim settlement	L
Mandat zum Schutz des katholischen Gottesdienstes [4. Februar 1550]	1550	Imperial city of Strasbourg	20/1, p. 372	1320	Under the Interim	L
Mandat zum Abendmahl unter beiderlei Gestalt 1552	1552	City of Soest	22, p. 472	1531	After the Interim	L

Several orders of the set are **described but not printed** because they are Interim orders:

- the Saxon (Leipzig) Interim agenda of 1549 (Sehling 1, p. 102; Sehling 2, pp. 501-505);
- the planned Hamburg Interim church order (Sehling 5, p. 484);
- the Brandenburg Interim order (Sehling 3, pp. 12, 177);
- the Göttingen "church order under the Interim" of 1550 (Sehling 6/2, p. 904);
- the Nuremberg Interim agenda (Sehling 11, pp. 328, 482);
- the Augsburg Interim forms (Sehling 12, p. 28);
- the draft of a Prussian church order "on the basis of the Interim" (Sehling 4, p. 22).

Some cities kept Interim usages long after 1552. Schwäbisch Hall kept its Interim order until 1559 (Sehling 17/1, p. 34), and in Ansbach-Kulmbach the Mass vestment stayed "as a remnant of the Interim time" (Sehling 11, p. 292).

1.5 The territories at a glance

Territory	Sehling	§	Texts	Years	Tradition
Martin Luther's orders	1	1.6.1	9	1523-1526	Lutheran
Saxony: editor's introductions	1	1.6.2	14	1527-1578	Lutheran
Ernestine Saxony	1	1.6.3	26	1527-1580	Lutheran
Albertine Saxony	1	1.6.4	23	1539-1580	Lutheran

Territory	Sehling	§	Texts	Years	Tradition
Freiberg and Wolkenstein (Duke Henry)	1	1.6.5	3	1537-1538	Lutheran
Towns of Ernestine and Albertine Saxony	1	1.6.6	133	1522-1582	Lutheran
Bishoprics of Merseburg, Meissen, Naumburg-Zeitz and Wurzen	2	1.7.1	21	1527-1578	Lutheran
Amt Stolpen and Bischofswerda	2	1.7.2	2	1559-1559	Lutheran
Lordship and town of Plauen	2	1.7.3	2	1529-1532	Lutheran
Lordship of Ronneburg	2	1.7.4	1	1529-1529	Lutheran
Schwarzburg	2	1.7.5	8	1532-1587	Lutheran
Reuss	2	1.7.6	8	1532-1560	Lutheran
Schönburg	2	1.7.7	2	1542-1582	Lutheran
Harz counties (Mansfeld, Stolberg, Hohenstein, Regenstein, Quedlinburg)	2	1.7.8	9	1540-1586	Lutheran
County of Henneberg	2	1.7.9	27	1545-1635	Lutheran
Mainz possessions (Eichsfeld, Erfurt, Querfurt)	2	1.7.10	4	1525-1583	Lutheran
Imperial cities of Mühlhausen and Nordhausen	2	1.7.11	6	1541-1571	Lutheran
Archbishopric of Magdeburg and Bishopric of Halberstadt	2	1.7.12	28	1524-1589	Lutheran
Principality of Anhalt	2	1.7.13	32	1532-1599	Lutheran; Philippist from 1590; Reformed from 1596
Naumburg cathedral (supplement)	2	1.7.14	1	1543-1543	Lutheran
Electorate of Brandenburg	3	1.8.1	7	1540-1600	Lutheran
Lordships of Beeskow and Storkow	3	1.8.2	3	1570-1585	Lutheran
Lands of the von der Schulenburg family	3	1.8.3	1	1572-1572	Lutheran
Towns of the Mark Brandenburg	3	1.8.4	57	1540-1603	Lutheran
Upper and Lower Lusatia	3	1.8.5	14	1525-1595	Lutheran

Territory	Sehling	§	Texts	Years	Tradition
Silesia	3	1.8.6	35	1521-1592	Lutheran
Duchy of Prussia	4	1.9.1	38	1524-1588	Lutheran
Royal Prussia: Danzig, Elbing, Thorn and their lands	4	1.9.2	23	1525-1612	Lutheran
Greater Poland (Posen): synods, the Bohemian Brethren and the towns	4	1.9.3	18	1560-1616	Sandomierz consensus
Duchy of Pomerania	4	1.9.4	47	1525-1616	Lutheran
Livonia	5	1.10.1	8	1530-1554	Lutheran
Estonia (Reval)	5	1.10.2	5	1524-1525	Lutheran
Courland	5	1.10.3	11	1560-1591	Lutheran
Mecklenburg	5	1.10.4	43	1530-1585	Lutheran
Lübeck with Bergedorf	5	1.10.5	11	1531-1588	Lutheran
Lauenburg and the Land Hadeln	5	1.10.6	3	1542-1599	Lutheran
Hamburg	5	1.10.7	5	1529-1570	Lutheran
Principality of Wolfenbüttel	6/1	1.11.1	4	1542-1569	Lutheran
Town of Braunschweig	6/1	1.11.2	7	1528-1571	Lutheran
Principality of Lüneburg	6/1	1.11.3	10	1527-1583	Lutheran
Town of Lüneburg	6/1	1.11.4	5	1531-1598	Lutheran
Principality of Calenberg-Göttingen	6/2	1.12.1	12	1542-1601	Lutheran
Town of Göttingen	6/2	1.12.2	2	1531-1568	Lutheran
Town of Northeim	6/2	1.12.3	1	1539-1539	Lutheran
Town of Hannover	6/2	1.12.4	1	1536-1536	Lutheran
Principality of Grubenhagen	6/2	1.12.5	7	1538-1600	Lutheran

Territory	Sehling	§	Texts	Years	Tradition
Town of Einbeck	6/2	1.12.6	1	1543-1543	Lutheran
Counties of Hoya and Diepholz	6/2	1.12.7	2	1571-1581	Lutheran
Archbishopric of Bremen	7/1	1.13.1	8	1574-1616	Lutheran
Town of Stade	7/1	1.13.2	1	1620-1620	Lutheran
Town of Buxtehude	7/1	1.13.3	2	1552-1565	Lutheran
Bishopric of Verden	7/1	1.13.4	1	1606-1606	Lutheran
Bishopric of Osnabrück	7/1	1.13.5	3	1543-1543	Lutheran
Town of Osnabrück	7/1	1.13.6	5	1543-1618	Lutheran
East Frisia: comital orders	7/1	1.13.7	6	1529-1549	Lutheran
East Frisia: treaties	7/1	1.13.8	2	1595-1599	Reformed/Lutheran
East Frisia: Reformed orders of limited range (Norden, Emden, Leer, Lütetsburg; London)	7/1	1.13.9	15	1528-1606	Reformed
East Frisia and Harlingerland: Lutheran orders of limited range	7/1	1.13.10	4	1574-1593	Lutheran
Bishopric of Hildesheim (Steuerwald and Peine)	7/2.1	1.14.1	3	1560-1574	Lutheran
Town of Hildesheim	7/2.1	1.14.2	14	1543-1597	Lutheran
County of Oldenburg	7/2.1	1.14.3	9	1573-1609	Lutheran
Lordship of Jever	7/2.1	1.14.4	11	1558-1596	Lutheran
County of Schaumburg	7/2.2	1.15.1	25	1559-1615	Lutheran
Imperial city of Goslar	7/2.2	1.15.2	35	1528-1617	Lutheran
City of Bremen	7/2.2	1.15.3	38	1525-1616	Lutheran; Philippist from 1562; Reformed from 1580
Landgraviate of Hesse under Philip (to 1567)	8	1.16.1	21	1526-1566	Moderate Reformed

Territory	Sehling	§	Texts	Years	Tradition
The Hessian landgraviates: joint synods and orders (1567-1582)	8	1.16.2	16	1568-1582	Philippist
Divided Hesse (1582-1618)	9	1.17.1	19	1574-1618	Philippist; Reformed (Hessen-Kassel) from 1600
County of Waldeck	9	1.17.2	27	1525-1590	Lutheran
County of Solms	9	1.17.3	10	1580-1616	Lutheran
County of Erbach	9	1.17.4	6	1544-1587	Lutheran
County of Stolberg-Königstein	9	1.17.5	1	1540-1540	Lutheran
Imperial city of Frankfurt	9	1.17.6	26	1530-1618	Moderate Reformed; Lutheran from 1535
Imperial castle and city of Friedberg	9	1.17.7	4	1565-1619	Lutheran
Imperial city of Gelnhausen	9	1.17.8	3	1566-1599	Lutheran
Imperial city of Wetzlar	9	1.17.9	5	1561-1596	Lutheran
Nassau-Dillenburg	10	1.18.1	29	1532-1618	Lutheran; Philippist from 1573; Reformed from 1578
Nassau-Weilburg and Nassau-Saarbrücken	10	1.18.2	7	1554-1617	Lutheran
Nassau-Wiesbaden and Nassau-Idstein	10	1.18.3	4	1582-1590	Lutheran
County of Hanau-Münzenberg	10	1.18.4	29	1543-1614	Lutheran; Reformed from 1595
County of Ysenburg	10	1.18.5	30	1544-1614	Lutheran
Imperial city of Nuremberg (to 1528)	11	1.19.1	8	1522-1526	Lutheran
Brandenburg-Ansbach-Kulmbach (to 1528)	11	1.19.2	11	1523-1528	Lutheran
Brandenburg and Nuremberg together (1528-1533)	11	1.19.3	6	1528-1533	Lutheran
Brandenburg-Ansbach-Kulmbach (from 1528/1533)	11	1.19.4	21	1526-1594	Lutheran
Imperial city of Nuremberg (from 1533)	11	1.19.5	3	1545-1582	Lutheran
Imperial city of Rothenburg ob der Tauber	11	1.19.6	2	1558-1559	Lutheran

Territory	Sehling	§	Texts	Years	Tradition
Imperial city of Schweinfurt with Gochsheim and Sennfeld	11	1.19.7	3	1543-1576	Lutheran
Imperial city of Weißenburg (Franconia)	11	1.19.8	2	1528-1590	Lutheran
Imperial city of Windsheim	11	1.19.9	1	1524-1524	Lutheran
County of Castell	11	1.19.10	1	1579-1579	Lutheran
County of Rieneck	11	1.19.11	2	1544-1588	Lutheran
County of Wertheim	11	1.19.12	2	1524-1555	Lutheran
Lordship of Thüngen	11	1.19.13	2	1564-1587	Lutheran
Imperial city of Augsburg	12	1.20.1	17	1523-1591	Moderate Reformed (Rhegius's baptism rite Lutheran); Lutheran from 1549
Imperial city of Dinkelsbühl	12	1.20.2	9	1535-1574	Lutheran
Imperial city of Donauwörth	12	1.20.3	1	1545-1545	Lutheran
Imperial city of Kempten	12	1.20.4	1	1553-1553	Lutheran
Imperial city of Lindau	12	1.20.5	5	1533-1573	Moderate Reformed; Lutheran from 1549
Imperial city of Memmingen	12	1.20.6	5	1528-1569	Moderate Reformed; Lutheran from 1549
Imperial city of Nördlingen	12	1.20.7	7	1522-1579	Lutheran
County of Oettingen-Oettingen	12	1.20.8	1	1591-1591	Lutheran
Duchy of Pfalz-Neuburg	13	1.21.1	28	1542-1577	Lutheran
Upper Palatinate (Electoral Palatinate)	13	1.21.2	22	1544-1615	Lutheran; Reformed from 1559; Lutheran from 1577; Reformed from 1583
Imperial city of Regensburg	13	1.21.3	24	1542-1599	Lutheran
County of Ortenburg	13	1.21.4	3	1563-1578	Lutheran
Lordship of Rothenberg	13	1.21.5	3	1601-1618	Lutheran
Lordship of Wolfstein	13	1.21.6	2	1574-1574	Lutheran

Territory	Sehling	§	Texts	Years	Tradition
Electoral Palatinate (Kurpfalz)	14	1.22.1	110	1546-1615	Lutheran; Reformed 1561-1576; Lutheran 1577-1583 (Reformed in Pfalz-Lautern); Reformed from 1583
County of Hohenlohe	15	1.23.1	108	1544-1615	Lutheran
Duchy of Württemberg (with Mömpelgard and Horburg)	16	1.24.1	73	1534-1614	Lutheran
Margraviate of Baden	16	1.24.2	21	1528-1617	Lutheran
County of Limpurg	16	1.24.3	9	1537-1620	Lutheran
Lordship of Kinzigtal (Fürstenberg)	16	1.24.4	4	1542-1546	Lutheran
Lordship of Neckarbischofsheim	16	1.24.5	1	1560-1560	Lutheran
Imperial city of Schwäbisch Hall	17/1	1.25.1	21	1526-1615	Lutheran
Imperial city of Heilbronn	17/1	1.25.2	18	1528-1603	Lutheran
Imperial city of Konstanz	17/1	1.25.3	19	1524-1548	Moderate Reformed
Imperial city of Isny	17/1	1.25.4	5	1533-1600	Moderate Reformed; Lutheran from 1549
Imperial city of Gengenbach	17/1	1.25.5	8	1538-1545	Moderate Reformed
Württemberg: school orders of the Great Church Order of 1559 (supplement to vol. 16)	17/1	1.25.6	7	1559-1559	Lutheran
Imperial city of Reutlingen	17/2	1.26.1	5	1528-1574	Lutheran
Imperial city of Ulm	17/2	1.26.2	35	1528-1600	Moderate Reformed; Lutheran from 1549
Imperial city of Esslingen	17/2	1.26.3	40	1531-1602	Moderate Reformed; Lutheran from 1549
Imperial city of Giengen an der Brenz	17/2	1.26.4	1	1583-1583	Lutheran
Imperial city of Biberach an der Riß	17/2	1.26.5	6	1531-1563	Moderate Reformed; Lutheran from 1549
Imperial city of Ravensburg	17/2	1.26.6	11	1545-1610	Lutheran
Imperial city of Wimpfen	17/2	1.26.7	8	1545-1589	Lutheran

Territory	Sehling	§	Texts	Years	Tradition
Imperial city of Leutkirch	17/2	1.26.8	5	1562-1605	Lutheran
Imperial city of Bopfingen	17/2	1.26.9	3	1546-1607	Lutheran
Imperial city of Aalen	17/2	1.26.10	2	1575-1576	Lutheran
Duchy of Pfalz-Zweibrücken	18	1.27.1	42	1533-1617	Lutheran; Reformed from 1588
County of Pfalz-Veldenz with Lützelstein and Guttenberg	18	1.27.2	6	1558-1605	Lutheran
Counties of Sponheim	18	1.27.3	11	1560-1617	Lutheran
Lordship of Sickingen	18	1.27.4	2	1564-1572	Lutheran
County of Manderscheid-Schleiden	18	1.27.5	1	1566-1566	Lutheran
Imperial city of Landau	19/1	1.28.1	12	1526-1611	Moderate Reformed; Lutheran from 1555
Imperial city of Speyer	19/1	1.28.2	10	1525-1612	Lutheran
Imperial city of Worms	19/1	1.28.3	4	1524-1560	Moderate Reformed; Lutheran from 1552
Counties of Leiningen	19/1	1.28.4	11	1566-1617	Lutheran
County of Sayn	19/1	1.28.5	16	1560-1619	Lutheran; Reformed from 1605
County of Wied	19/1	1.28.6	8	1564-1619	Reformed
Wild- and Rhinegraviate	19/2	1.29.1	22	1563-1618	Lutheran
Principality of Pfalz-Simmern	19/2	1.29.2	3	1560-1598	Lutheran; Reformed from 1598
County of Pfalz-Veldenz (supplement to vol. 18)	19/2	1.29.3	1	1571-1571	Lutheran
Electoral Palatinate (supplement to vol. 14)	19/2	1.29.4	72	1546-1610	Lutheran; Reformed from 1561; Lutheran from 1577 (Reformed in Pfalz-Lautern); Reformed from 1583
Imperial city of Strasbourg	20/1	1.30.1	79	1523-1617	Moderate Reformed; Lutheran from 1549
County of Hanau-Lichtenberg	20/2	1.31.1	7	1545-1614	Lutheran
Lordship of Fleckenstein	20/2	1.31.2	1	n.d.	Lutheran

Territory	Sehling	§	Texts	Years	Tradition
Lordship of Rappoltstein	20/2	1.31.3	12	1553-1569	Lutheran
Imperial city of Mülhausen (Mulhouse)	20/2	1.31.4	27	1523-1582	Reformed
Imperial city of Weißenburg (Alsace)	20/2	1.31.5	2	1560-1613	Lutheran
Münster im Gregoriental	20/2	1.31.6	7	1575-1604	Lutheran
Imperial city of Hagenau	20/2	1.31.7	12	1565-1617	Lutheran
Imperial city of Colmar	20/2	1.31.8	16	1575-1615	Lutheran; Moderate Reformed from 1578
United Duchies of Jülich-Cleves-Berg	21	1.32.1	18	1525-1572	Roman Catholic humanist
Bishopric and town of Minden	21	1.32.2	7	1530-1604	Lutheran
Imperial abbey and town of Herford	21	1.32.3	1	1532-1532	Lutheran
Imperial city of Dortmund	21	1.32.4	6	1532-1596	Lutheran
Imperial abbey of Corvey (Höxter)	21	1.32.5	3	1533-1603	Lutheran
County of Lippe	21	1.32.6	12	1537-1617	Lutheran; Reformed from 1600
Imperial abbey and town of Essen	21	1.32.7	5	1561-1581	Lutheran
Archbishopric of Cologne	22	1.33.1	3	1546-1583	Moderate Reformed; Reformed from 1583
County of Wittgenstein	22	1.33.2	21	1555-1611	Lutheran; Reformed from 1574
County of Moers	22	1.33.3	6	1561-1603	Lutheran; Reformed from 1578
County of Bentheim-Tecklenburg	22	1.33.4	12	1543-1619	Lutheran; Reformed from 1586
County of Rietberg	22	1.33.5	2	1566-1568	Lutheran
City of Münster	22	1.33.6	6	1532-1534	Moderate Reformed
City of Soest	22	1.33.7	13	1532-1619	Lutheran
Town of Neuenrade	22	1.33.8	1	1564-1564	Lutheran

Territory	Sehling	§	Texts	Years	Tradition
County of Lippe (supplement)	22	1.33.9	1	1538-1538	Lutheran
Duchies of Schleswig and Holstein	23	1.34.1	68	1526-1617	Lutheran
Land of Dithmarschen	23	1.34.2	20	1532-1606	Lutheran
Principality of Transylvania: diets	24	1.35.1	26	1552-1619	Multi-confessional
Transylvanian Saxons	24	1.35.2	95	1543-1620	Lutheran

1.6 Volume 1: Saxony and Thuringia I: Luther; Ernestine and Albertine Saxony

208 texts.

1.6.1 Martin Luther's orders

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
9	Luther, Von ordnung gottis diensts in der gemeine	1523	1, p. 2	2	Agenda / liturgy	L	
10	Luther, Formula missae	1523	1, p. 3	2	Agenda / liturgy	L	
17	Luther, Deutsche Messe	1526	1, p. 10	2	Agenda / liturgy	L	
1	Luther, Wie man recht und vorstendlich ein menschen taufen sol	n.d.	1, p. 17	3	Agenda / liturgy	L	
11	Luther, Das taufbuchlein verdeutscht	1523	1, p. 18	3	Agenda / liturgy	L	
18	Luther, Das taufbüchlein verdeutscht, aufs neu zugericht	1526	1, p. 21	3	Agenda / liturgy	L	
2	Luther, Traubüchlein für die einfeltigen pfarherrn	n.d.	1, p. 23	3	Agenda / liturgy	L	
3	Luther, Formula ordinandorum ministrorum verbi	n.d.	1, p. 26	3	Agenda / liturgy	L	
4	Luther, Formula ordinationis latina, que usurpatur , quando peregrini.germanicum linguam non intelligunt	n.d.	1, p. 27	3	Agenda / liturgy	L	

1.6.2 Saxony: editor's introductions

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.
- **Note**: Orders printed in whole or part in Sehling's introduction.

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
19	Die artikel so durch die rethe zur visitation .. .. bedacht	1527	1, p. 37	6	Visitation	L	
68	Schmiedeberg. Ordnung der Visitatoren	1533	1, p. 51	6	Visitation	L	
86	Abschied der Visitatoren für Grimma	1534	1, p. 53	6	Visitation	L	
87	Ordnung der Visitatoren für Eilenburg	1534	1, p. 53	6	Visitation	L	
132	Reskript Johann Friedrich des Mittleren. Vom 23. October 1551	1551	1, p. 61	6	Mandate / decree	L	
133	Ordnung der Visitatoren für Saalfeld	1554	1, p. 63	6	Visitation	L	
169	Drei Examensartikel für Weimar	1573	1, p. 68	6	Articles / statutes	L	
189	Verordnung des Kurfürsten August vom 13. Oct	1578	1, p. 77	6	Mandate / decree	L	
138	Verordnung der Visitatoren für Kemberg	1555	1, p. 106	7	Visitation	L	
161	Investitur des Pfarrers von Wittenberg	1569	1, p. 107	7	Agenda / liturgy	L	
190	Propositio des ersten Generalsynodus zu Dresden 1578	1578	1, p. 113	7	Consistory / synod / government	L	
191	Siebenlehn. Bericht auf der Visitation von 1578	1578	1, p. 126	7	Visitation	L	
192	Weissenborn. Bericht auf der Visitation. 1578	1578	1, p. 126	7	Visitation	L	
193	Bericht aus der Superintendenz Chemnitz 1578	1578	1, p. 127	7	Consistory / synod / government	L	

1.6.3 Ernestine Saxony

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
20	Instruktion der Visitatoren. 16. Juni 1527	1527	1, p. 142	8	Visitation	L	
21	Herzog Hansen churfursten artikel	1527	1, p. 148	8	Articles / statutes	L	
	Unterricht der visitatoren im kurfürstenthum zu Sachsen	1528	1, p. 149	9	Catechism / instruction	L	
96	Revision des „Unterricht der Visitatoren“ durch Luther	1538	1, p. 149	9	Catechism / instruction	L	
14	Verordnung betr. Ankündigung der Visitation, 6. Sept. 1528	1527	1, p. 174	10	Visitation	L	
25	Verordnung aus der Visitation von 1528/1529	1527	1, p. 175	11	Visitation	L	

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
31	Verordnungen aus der Visitation 1528/1529	1529	1, p. 175	11	Visitation	L	
66	Ausschreiben durchs churfürstenthumb zu Sachsen vom 6. Juni 1531	1531	1, p. 178	12	Mandate / decree	L	
67	Instruktion zur Visitation	1532	1, p. 183	13	Visitation	L	
69	Gemeine verordnung der visitation in Meissen und der Voitland	1533	1, p. 187	14	Visitation	L	
120	Verordnung der Visitatoren für Wurzen	1542	1, p. 187	14	Visitation	L	
70	Artikel gemeiner Verschaffung, aus der visitation in Thüringen	1533	1, p. 195	15	Visitation	L	
71	Verordnung für Adel und Ritterschaft des Orts Franken	1533	1, p. 197	16	Mandate / decree	L	
92	Verordnung der Visitatoren für Franken	1535	1, p. 198	17	Visitation	L	
72	Patent betr. die geistlichen Zinse. 4. Decbr	1533	1, p. 200	18	Mandate / decree	L	
121	Constitution des consistorii zu Wittenberg	1542	1, p. 200	18	Consistory / synod / government	L	
125	Wittenbergische Reformation	1545	1, p. 209	20	Church order	L	
134	Visitationsinstruktion vom 17. Juni 1554	1554	1, p. 222	20	Visitation	L	
152	Polizei- und landsordnung, im Ernestinischen Sachsen	1556	1, p. 228	21	Discipline / police	L	
157	Ordnung und summarischer process des consistorii (zu Weimar)	1561	1, p. 230	23	Consistory / synod / government	L	
162	Ordnung und reformation consistorii zu Jena	1569	1, p. 233	24	Consistory / synod / government	L	
163	Instruktion Johann Wilhelms zur Partikularvisitation	1569	1, p. 242	24	Visitation	L	
164	Process oder memoriale der visitation	1569	1, p. 245	24	Visitation	L	
170	Consistorial-Ordnung zu Jena	1574	1, p. 248	25	Consistory / synod / government	L	
204	Beschlüsse des Coburgischen Synodus	1580	1, p. 252	26	Consistory / synod / government	L	
98	Instruktion für die erste Visitation Herzog Heinrichs	1539	1, p. 257	27	Visitation	L	

1.6.4 Albertine Saxony

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
99	Die vier artikel den dorfpfarrern furgehalten	1539	1, p. 263	29	Other	L	
100	Kirchen-Ordnung zum anfang ..... in herzog Heinrichs zu Sachsen fürstenthum	1539	1, p. 264	30	Church order	L	
101	Instruktion zur zweiten Visitation	1539	1, p. 281	31	Visitation	L	
112	Gemeiner bericht der visitatoren an die pfarrer in herzog Heinrichs ... lande	1540	1, p. 284	32	Visitation	L	
123	Ordnung Herzogs Moritz. 21. Mai	1543	1, p. 286	32	Local order	L	
124	Ordnung Herzogs Moritz. 21. Mai	1543	1, p. 290	32	Local order	L	
126	a) Consistorial-Ordnung	1545	1, p. 291	33	Consistory / synod / government	L	
127	b) Ehebedenken	1545	1, p. 292	33	Marriage	L	
128	c) Kirchen-Ordnung	1545	1, p. 297	33	Church order	L	
129	Ausschreiben des Herzogs Augustus, betr. die heimlichen Verlöbnisse	1545	1, p. 304	34	Mandate / decree	L	
139	Instruktion zur Visitation	1555	1, p. 305	35	Visitation	L	
140	Generalia, alle superintendentes belangende	1555	1, p. 311	36	Visitation	L	
155	General - Artikel des Kurfürsten August. Vom 8. Mai	1557	1, p. 316	36	Articles / statutes	L	
141	Landes-Ordnung des Kurfürsten August. Vom 1. October	1555	1, p. 340	38	Discipline / police	L	
153	Dresdener Ehe-Ordnung	1556	1, p. 343	39	Marriage	L	
185	Visitations - Instruktion des Kurfürsten August. Vom 4. Juni	1577	1, p. 346	39	Visitation	L	
186	Visitations-Instruktion des Kurfürsten August für das Ernestinische Sachsen	1577	1, p. 346	39	Visitation	L	
171	Instruktion für die Visitation 1574/1575	1574	1, p. 352	40	Visitation	L	
172	Verordnung der Visitatoren im meissnischen Kreise	1574	1, p. 354	42	Visitation	L	

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
194	Verordnung des Kurfürsten August auf die Visitationen von 1574, 1575, 1577. Vom 28. Mai	1578	1, p. 356	42	Visitation	L	
195	Pfarr-Wittwen und -Waisen-Ordnung des Consistoriums zu Wittenberg	1578	1, p. 358	43	Consistory / synod / government	L	
205	Kirchen-Ordnung des Kurfürsten August	1580	1, p. 359	44	Church order	L	
206	Notarien-Ordnung	1580	1, p. 457	45	Consistory / synod / government	L	

1.6.5 Freiberg and Wolkenstein (Duke Henry)

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
94	Visitationsinstruktion Herzog Heinrichs für Freiberg. Vom 26. Mai	1537	1, p. 460	47	Visitation	L	
95	Visitationsartikel des Dr. Jacob Schenk	1537	1, p. 465	48	Visitation	L	
97	Visitation verordnung zu Freiberg	1538	1, p. 467	49	Visitation	L	

1.6.6 Towns of Ernestine and Albertine Saxony

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.
- **Texts by tradition**: Lutheran 130, Radical Reformation (Müntzer) 3.

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
5	Münzer, Deutsch kirchenampt	n.d.	1, p. 472	50	Agenda / liturgy	RAD	Thomas Müntzer
13	Münzer, Deutsch evangelisch messe	1524	1, p. 497	51	Agenda / liturgy	RAD	Thomas Müntzer
14	Münzer, Ordnung und berechnung des teutschen ampts zu Alstadt	1524	1, p. 504	52	Agenda / liturgy	RAD	Thomas Müntzer
73	Ordnungen der Visitatoren für Allstedt, a) u. b)	1533	1, p. 507	53	Visitation	L	
159	Statuta .... einer .... polizei für die stadt Allstedt	1564	1, p. 513	54	Articles / statutes	L	
22	Ordnung des gemeinen kastens zu Altenburg	1527	1, p. 514	55	Poor relief	L	
74	Verordnung der ceremonien ... für den stift ... zu Aldenburg	1533	1, p. 515	56	Agenda / liturgy	L	

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
75	Verordnung der stat Altenburg	1533	1, p. 516	56	Mandate / decree	L	
135	Ordnung der Visitatoren für Altenburg	1554	1, p. 518	58	Visitation	L	
173	Gottesdienst-Ordnung von Albrechtshain	1574	1, p. 518	58	Agenda / liturgy	L	
102	Verordnung der Visitatoren für Annaberg	1539	1, p. 520	59	Visitation	L	
142	Verordnung der Visitatoren für die Stadt Annaberg	1555	1, p. 521	60	Visitation	L	
32	Ordnung für Baruth	1529	1, p. 524	61	Local order	L	
33	Ordnung für Belgern	1529	1, p. 525	61	Local order	L	
174	Gottesdienst-Ordnung für Beucha	1574	1, p. 525	61	Agenda / liturgy	L	
34	Ordnung für Belzig	1529	1, p. 527	63	Local order	L	
35	Generalia für die Dörfer des Amtes Belzig	1529	1, p. 528	63	Visitation	L	
88	Generalia aller dorfer im amt Belzig	1534	1, p. 529	64	Visitation	L	
36	Ordnung für die Stadt Bitterfeld	1529	1, p. 530	65	Local order	L	
203	Ordnung der Hochzeiten und Taufen für die Stadt Belzig	1579	1, p. 530	65	Agenda / liturgy	L	
37	Ordnung für die Stadt Brandis	1529	1, p. 531	66	Local order	L	
65	Ordnung für die Stadt Bruck	1530	1, p. 534	67	Local order	L	
175	Gottesdienst-Ordnung für Brandis	1574	1, p. 534	67	Agenda / liturgy	L	
89	Verordnung im closter zum Buch	1534	1, p. 536	69	Monastery / chapter	L	
122	Ausschreiben des Herzogs Moritz	1542	1, p. 538	69	Mandate / decree	L	
113	Gemeiner bericht der visitatoren an den pfarrer, rath und gemein zu Kempnitz	1540	1, p. 539	70	Visitation	L	
143	Verordnung der Visitatoren für Chemnitz	1555	1, p. 540	71	Visitation	L	
15	Gottesdienst-Ordnung der stadt Coburg	1524	1, p. 542	72	Agenda / liturgy	L	

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
130	Verordnung und bestellung des kirchendiensts der pfarrn in der stadt Coburg	1545	1, p. 543	73	Appointment / oath	L	
144	Vorschaffung zu Coburg	1555	1, p. 544	74	Articles / statutes	L	
38	Verordnung für die Stadt Colditz	1529	1, p. 545	75	Mandate / decree	L	
145	Visitationsabschied für die Stadt Döbeln	1555	1, p. 547	75	Visitation	L	
196	Gottesdienst-Ordnung für Chemnitz 5-G *197. Gottesdienst-Ordnung für Dohna	1578	1, p. 550	76	Agenda / liturgy	L	
39	Ordnung der Visitatoren für Domitzsch	1529	1, p. 551	77	Visitation	L	
103	Verordnung der Visitatoren für Dresden	1539	1, p. 554	78	Visitation	L	
176	Gottesdienst-Ordnung der Kreuzkirche zu Dresden	1574	1, p. 555	78	Agenda / liturgy	L	
198	Gottesdienst-Ordnung zu Dresden	1578	1, p. 556	79	Agenda / liturgy	L	
156	Instruktion für die Verwaltung des gemeinen Kastens in Alt-Dresden	1558	1, p. 557	80	Poor relief	L	
208	Form der allgemeinen Beichte und Absolution zu Dresden	1581	1, p. 557	80	Agenda / liturgy	L	
40	Ordnung der Visitatoren für die Stadt Düben	1529	1, p. 559	81	Visitation	L	
41	Ordnung der Visitatoren für die Stadt Eilenburg	1529	1, p. 560	82	Visitation	L	
158	Polizei-Ordnung der Stadt Eisenberg	1563	1, p. 561	83	Discipline / police	L	
136	Verordnung der visitatorn für den Superintendenten zu Eisfeld	1554	1, p. 562	84	Visitation	L	
137	Ordnung der kirchen ceremonien vor die pfarher auf den dorfern bei Eisfeld	1554	1, p. 562	84	Church order	L	
104	Visitationsartikel für den pfarrer zum Gnandstein	1539	1, p. 564	85	Visitation	L	
114	Gemeiner bericht der visitatoren ... an den pfarrer und dorfschaft zu Gnandstein	1540	1, p. 564	85	Visitation	L	
187	Verzeichniss der Kirchen-Ordnung zu Gottleuba	1577	1, p. 567	87	Church order	L	
146	Artikel durch die herrn visitatores.zu Gotha	1555	1, p. 569	88	Visitation	L	

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
42	Ordnung der Visitatoren für die Stadt Grimma	1529	1, p. 571	89	Visitation	L	
43	Generalia aller flecke und dorfer im amte Grimma	1529	1, p. 575	90	Visitation	L	
177	Ordnung der Predigten und Kinderlehre zu Grossdalzig	1574	1, p. 576	90	Catechism / instruction	L	
199	Registratur von der Lokal-Visitation für Hayn	1578	1, p. 577	91	Visitation	L	
44	Ordnung der Visitatoren für die Stadt Herzberg	1529	1, p. 578	92	Visitation	L	
45	Ordnung der Visitatoren für das Dorf Altherzberg	1529	1, p. 580	92	Visitation	L	
46	Ordnung der Visitatoren für die Stadt Jessen	1529	1, p. 581	93	Visitation	L	
165	Kirchen-Ordnung zu Kapellendorf	1569	1, p. 582	94	Church order	L	
166	Gottesdienst-Ordnung für die Filialen von Kapellendorf	1569	1, p. 583	95	Agenda / liturgy	L	
26	Verordnung der Visitatoren für die Stadt Kemberg	1527	1, p. 584	96	Visitation	L	
105	Visitationsartikel für die Klöster zu Leipzig	1539	1, p. 589	97	Visitation	L	
106	Ordnung für die Klosterjungfrauen zu Leipzig	1539	1, p. 589	97	Monastery / chapter	L	
107	Gemeines Fürhalten zu Leipzig	1539	1, p. 590	98	Articles / statutes	L	
108	Verordnungen der Visitatoren zu Leipzig	1539	1, p. 591	99	Visitation	L	
109	Kirchen-Ordnung einem erbarn rath zu Leipzig zugestelt	1539	1, p. 593	100	Church order	L	
	1567, †160. Gemein Gebet zu Leipzig	1564	1, p. 595	101	Agenda / liturgy	L	
12	Ordnung eines gemeinen Kastens zu Leisnig	1523	1, p. 598	102	Poor relief	L	
47	Verordnung der Visitatoren für die Stadt Leisnig	1529	1, p. 605	103	Visitation	L	
48	Verordnung der Visitatoren für das Amt zu Leisnig	1529	1, p. 609	104	Visitation	L	
202	Hochzeits-Ordnung für Leisnig	1579	1, p. 610	105	Marriage	L	
49	Verordnung der Visitatoren für die Stadt Liebenwerda	1529	1, p. 611	106	Visitation	L	

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
76	Verordnung der Visitatoren für die Stadt Lieben- . werda	1533	1, p. 613	107	Visitation	L	
	50 Verordnung der Visitatoren für die Stadt Lochau	1529	1, p. 614	108	Visitation	L	
77	Generalia aller dörfer im amt Liebenwerde	1533	1, p. 614	108	Visitation	L	
	51 Verordnung der Visitatoren für die Stadt Niemegk	1529	1, p. 615	109	Visitation	L	
52	Verordnung der Visitatoren für das Kloster Nimbschen	1529	1, p. 616	110	Visitation	L	
78	Verordnung der Visitatoren für das Kloster Nimbschen	1533	1, p. 618	111	Visitation	L	
79	Verordnung der Visitatoren für Oelsnitz	1533	1, p. 620	112	Visitation	L	
209	Verordnung der Visitatoren für Oelsnitz	1582	1, p. 620	112	Visitation	L	
110	Verordnung der Visitatoren zu Oschatz	1539	1, p. 622	113	Visitation	L	
115	Verordnung der Visitatoren für Ochatz	1540	1, p. 625	114	Visitation	L	
147	Abschied, das geistliche einkommen der stadt Oschatz betr	1555	1, p. 627	115	Treaty / agreement	L	
148	Visitationsabschied für Oschatz	1555	1, p. 630	115	Visitation	L	
182	Kirchen-Ordnung für Penig	1575	1, p. 634	116	Church order	L	
111	Verordnung der Visitatoren für Pirna	1539	1, p. 636	117	Visitation	L	
116	Gemeiner Bericht der Visitatoren für Pirna	1540	1, p. 637	118	Visitation	L	
149	Abschied der Visitatoren für Pirna	1555	1, p. 638	119	Visitation	L	
6	Kirchen - Ordnung für die Stadt Pirna, verfasst von Anton Lauterbach	n.d.	1, p. 641	119	Church order	L	
200	Kirchen-Ordnung für Pirna	1578	1, p. 645	120	Church order	L	
53	Ordination der dorfer dem.....closter Plötzke gehörig	1529	1, p. 646	121	Agenda / liturgy	L	
54	Ordination für Gommern und zugehörige Dorfschaften	1529	1, p. 647	122	Agenda / liturgy	L	
27	Generalia für Pollerstorf und andere Dörfer im Amt Wittenberg	1527	1, p. 648	123	Visitation	L	

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
80	Generalia für Pollerstorf und andere Dörfer im Amt Wittenberg	1533	1, p. 648	123	Visitation	L	
55	Verordnung der Visitatoren für die Stadt Prettin	1529	1, p. 649	124	Visitation	L	
	"81. Ordnung in das junkfrau closter zu Remse	1533	1, p. 651	125	Monastery / chapter	L	
82	Ordnung der junkfrauen closter zu Altenburg	1533	1, p. 651	125	Monastery / chapter	L	
178	Kirchen-Ordnung für Rötha	1574	1, p. 653	125	Church order	L	
117	Kirchen-Ordnung für Salza	1540	1, p. 654	125	Church order	L	
118	Ordnung der visitatorn zu Sangerhausen	1540	1, p. 656	127	Visitation	L	
150	Verordnung der Visitatoren für Sangerhausen	1555	1, p. 657	128	Visitation	L	
188	Gottesdienst-Ordnung zu Schandau	1577	1, p. 658	128	Agenda / liturgy	L	
56	Kirchen-Ordnung für die Stadt Schlieben	1529	1, p. 659	129	Church order	L	
57	Generalia der Pfarren im Amt Schlieben	1529	1, p. 661	130	Visitation	L	
28	Verordnung der Visitatoren für Schmiedeberg	1527	1, p. 662	131	Visitation	L	
58	Generalia der Dörfer im Amt Schlieben	1529	1, p. 662	131	Visitation	L	
90	Verordnung der Visitatoren für Schneeberg	1534	1, p. 666	133	Visitation	L	
59	Kirchen-Ordnung für Schönewalde	1529	1, p. 667	134	Church order	L	
183	Ordnung der predigten und kinderlehr zu Schneeberg	1575	1, p. 667	134	Catechism / instruction	L	
60	Kirchen-Ordnung für die Stadt Schweinitz	1529	1, p. 668	134	Church order	L	
29	Kirchen-Ordnung für die Stadt Seida	1527	1, p. 670	135	Church order	L	
151	Kirchen-Ordnung für die Stadt Senftenberg	1555	1, p. 671	136	Church order	L	
179	Ordnung der predigten und kinderlehr zu Gross- Storkwitz	1574	1, p. 673	137	Catechism / instruction	L	
180	Kirchen-Ordnung für Taucha	1574	1, p. 674	138	Church order	L	

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
61	Ordnung der Visitatoren für die Stadt Torgau	1529	1, p. 675	139	Visitation	L	
91	Artikel dem rat zu Torgau zugestellt	1534	1, p. 680	139	Articles / statutes	L	
184	Verordnung der Visitatoren zu Torgau	1575	1, p. 682	141	Visitation	L	
62	Kirchen-Ordnung für Wahrenbrück	1529	1, p. 686	142	Church order	L	
167	Generalia für die pfarreien der superintendenz Weimar	1570	1, p. 688	143	Visitation	L	
168	Specialartikel für die Stadt Weimar	1570	1, p. 690	144	Articles / statutes	L	
119	Ordnung der visitacion zu Weissenfels	1540	1, p. 692	144	Local order	L	
201	Ordnung der geseng, so zu Weissenfels. gehalten wird	1578	1, p. 693	145	Agenda / liturgy	L	
8	Kirchen-Ordnung für Wittenberg (Carlstadt)	1522	1, p. 697	146	Church order	L	Karlstadt's Wittenberg order
16	Wie es mit den ceremonien der kirchen gehalten wirt zu Wittenberg	1525	1, p. 698	147	Agenda / liturgy	L	
83	Kirchen-Ordnung für die Stadt Wittenberg	1533	1, p. 700	148	Church order	L	
7	Bericht über die von Bugenhagen in Wittenberg beobachtete Trauungsordnung	n.d.	1, p. 710	148	Agenda / liturgy	L	
30	Verordnung der Visitatoren für Zahna	1527	1, p. 711	149	Visitation	L	
84	Verordnung der Visitatoren für Zahna	1533	1, p. 715	150	Visitation	L	
181	Kirchen-Ordnung für Zehmen und Rüben	1574	1, p. 717	150	Church order	L	
63	Verordnung der Visitatoren für Zwickau	1529	1, p. 721	151	Visitation	L	
64	Kasten-Ordnung für Zwickau	1529	1, p. 722	151	Poor relief	L	
85	Verordnung der Visitatoren für Zwickau	1533	1, p. 723	152	Visitation	L	
93	Vertrag zwischen dem Rath der Stadt Zwickau und den Pfarrern	1536	1, p. 724	153	Treaty / agreement	L	
131	Ordnung der pfarren und kirchen zu Zwickau	1545	1, p. 725	154	Local order	L	

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
154	Verordnung der Visitatoren für Zwickau	1556	1, p. 726	155	Visitation	L	
207	Gottesdienst-Ordnung für Zwickau	1580	1, p. 727	156	Agenda / liturgy	L	

1.7 Volume 2: Saxony and Thuringia II: bishoprics, counties, Henneberg, Magdeburg, Anhalt

151 texts.

1.7.1 Bishoprics of Merseburg, Meissen, Naumburg-Zeitz and Wurzen

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
44	Ordinations-Ordnung. Entwurf	1545	2, p. 6	1210	Agenda / liturgy	L	
46	Bestellung des Consistoriums zu Merseburg	1545	2, p. 9	1210	Consistory / synod / government	L	
	Visitations-Ordnung im Stifte Merseburg	1544	2, p. 10	1210	Visitation	L	
43	Merseburger Synodalunterricht	1543	2, p. 12	1211	Catechism / instruction	L	
47	Kursächsische Superintendenten-Instruktion	1545	2, p. 12	1211	Consistory / synod / government	L	
48	Merseburger Synodal-Vorhaltung	1545	2, p. 25	1212	Consistory / synod / government	L	
49	Merseburger Artikel	1545	2, p. 27	1213	Other	L	
60	Einfältiger unterricht von verbotenen personen und graden u. s. w. in Merseburg	1548	2, p. 28	1213	Catechism / instruction	L	
45	Ordinations-Ordnung	1545	2, p. 36	1213	Agenda / liturgy	L	
1	Form der öffentlichen Busse für das Bisthum Merseburg	n.d.	2, p. 38	1213	Agenda / liturgy	L	
51	Ehe-Ordnung des Consistoriums zu Meissen	1545	2, p. 48	1214	Consistory / synod / government	L	
52	Consistorial-Ordnung für Meissen	1545	2, p. 49	1214	Consistory / synod / government	L	
61	Verordnung des Herzogs Moritz an das Consistorium zu Meissen	1548	2, p. 50	1215	Consistory / synod / government	L	
	Ordnung der Predigerunterstützungs -, Pfarrwittwen- und -Waisenkasse für die	1570	2, p. 50	1215	Consistory / synod /	L	

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
	Superintendenz Meissen				government		
28	Ordnung der Visitatoren für die Stadt Meissen	1540	2, p. 52	1216	Visitation	L	
12	Kirchen-Ordnung für die St. Wenzelskirche in Naumburg	1527	2, p. 59	1218	Church order	L	
26	Kirchen-Ordnung für die St. Wenzelskirche zu Naumburg	1537	2, p. 61	1219	Church order	L	
50	Kirchen-Ordnung des Bischofs von Naumburg-Zeitz	1545	2, p. 89	1219	Church order	L	
32	Kasten-Ordnung für Wurzen	1542	2, p. 93	1221	Poor relief	L	
33	Gemeine Artikel für Wurzen	1542	2, p. 94	1222	Articles / statutes	L	
	Artikul, worauf die pfarhern und custodes antworten sollen (Wurzen)	1578	2, p. 99	1224	Articles / statutes	L	

1.7.2 Amt Stolpen and Bischofswerda

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
79	Visitations-Rezess für die Stadt Bischofswerda	1559	2, p. 104	1226	Visitation	L	
80	Gottesdienst-Ordnung für die Stadt Bischofswerda	1559	2, p. 106	1226	Agenda / liturgy	L	

1.7.3 Lordship and town of Plauen

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
13	Ordnung der Ceremonien zu Plauen	1529	2, p. 110	1227	Agenda / liturgy	L	
15	Die von Hausmann für Dessau verfasste Ordnung 16. Visitations-Verordnung für Plauen	1532	2, p. 111	1227	Visitation	L	

1.7.4 Lordship of Ronneburg

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
14	Ordnung der Visitatoren für Ronneburg	1529	2, p. 115	1228	Visitation	L	

1.7.5 Schwarzburg

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
142	Visitations-Abschied für Schwarzburg	1587	2, p. 127	1230	Visitation	L	
17	Ordnung der Visitatoren für die Schwarzburgische Oberherrschaft	1532	2, p. 128	1230	Visitation	L	
18	Visitations-Artikel für das Amt Arnstadt	1532	2, p. 128	1230	Visitation	L	
63	Ordnung der religion, wie es in grafschaften Schwarzburg und Stolberg soll gehalten werden	1549	2, p. 129	1230	Local order	L	
	Form und mass der visitation im amt Rudolstadt	1575	2, p. 130	1230	Visitation	L	
	Ordo lectionum scholae nostrae Rudolstadiensis	1575	2, p. 131	1230	School / university	L	
	Gräflich Schwarzburgische Kirchen-Ordnung	1574	2, p. 132	1230	Church order	L	
143	Ordnung der Fest- und Feiertage für Schwarzburg	1587	2, p. 137	1230	Discipline / police	L	

1.7.6 Reuss

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
21	Verordnung der Visitatoren für den Rath der Stadt Schleiz	1532	2, p. 143	1234	Visitation	L	
22	Verordnung der Visitatoren für das Kloster Saalburg	1532	2, p. 143	1234	Visitation	L	
19	Verordnung der Visitatoren für den Hauptmann zu Gera	1532	2, p. 149	1234	Visitation	L	
20	Verordnung der Visitatoren für den Rath der Stadt Gera	1532	2, p. 150	1234	Visitation	L	
24	Verordnung der Visitatoren für Gera	1534	2, p. 151	1234	Visitation	L	
38	Kirchen-Ordnung für die Stadt Lobenstein	1543	2, p. 152	1234	Church order	L	
67	Kirchen-Ordnung Heinrich’s IV. von Reuss	1552	2, p. 153	1234	Church order	L	
81	Mandat und Consistorial-Ordnung für Mansfeld *82. Kirchen-Ordnung für die pfarrer der superintendenz Gera	1560	2, p. 158	1234	Mandate / decree	L	

1.7.7 Schönburg

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
136	Schönburg'scher Hausvertrag	1582	2, p. 166	1235	Treaty / agreement	L	
34	Kirchen-Ordnung der Schönburg'schen Gebiete	1542	2, p. 167	1235	Church order	L	

1.7.8 Harz counties (Mansfeld, Stolberg, Hohenstein, Regenstein, Quedlinburg)

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
118	Ankündigung der Visitation für das Amt Leinungen	1570	2, p. 182	1238	Visitation	L	
119	Ankündigung der Visitation für das Amt Rammelburg	1570	2, p. 182	1238	Visitation	L	
58	Vertrag zwischen den Grafen von Mansfeld, vermittelt durch Luther und Jonas	1546	2, p. 187	1240	Treaty / agreement	L	
68	Form und weise einer visitation für die grafschaft Mansfeld. (Sarcerius)	1554	2, p. 190	1240	Visitation	L	
141	Mansfeldische geistliche Consistorial-Ordnung	1586	2, p. 197	1240	Consistory / synod / government	L	
	Kirchen-Agende für die Grafschaft Mansfeld	1580	2, p. 215	1241	Agenda / liturgy	L	
2	Statut der Stadt Stolberg a./Harz	n.d.	2, p. 250	1242	Other	L	
3	Kirchen-Ordnung für das Gericht Wintzingerode oder Bodenstein	n.d.	2, p. 252	1243	Church order	L	
29	Kirchen-Ordnung für Quedlinburg	1540	2, p. 262	1244	Church order	L	

1.7.9 County of Henneberg

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
53	Mandat Wilhelm's von Henneberg	1545	2, p. 283	1247	Mandate / decree	L	
54	Mandat des Grafen Georg Ernst von Henneberg	1545	2, p. 284	1247	Mandate / decree	L	
	Mandat Georg Ernst's zu Henneberg	1574	2, p. 285	1247	Mandate / decree	L	

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
	Visitations- und Consistorial-Ordnung für Henneberg	1574	2, p. 286	1247	Visitation	L	
137	Kirchen-Ordnung Georg Ernst's von Henneberg	1582	2, p. 298	1247	Church order	L	
153	Bericht über die Bestellung und die Thätigkeit des Consistoriums zu Henneberg	1635	2, p. 325	1247	Consistory / synod / government	L	
72	Instruktion für die Visitatoren von Henneberg- Römhild	1556	2, p. 326	1247	Visitation	L	
73	Abschied der Visitatoren für die Superintendenz zu Römhild	1556	2, p. 328	1247	Visitation	L	
103	Gottesdienst-Ordnung für Belrieth und Einhausen	1566	2, p. 329	1248	Agenda / liturgy	L	
104	Kirchen-Ordnung für Dingsleben	1566	2, p. 331	1248	Church order	L	
105	Kirchen-Ordnung für Goldlauter	1566	2, p. 332	1248	Church order	L	
106	Kirchen-Ordnung für Herpf	1566	2, p. 334	1248	Church order	L	
107	Gottesdienst-Ordnung für Marisfeld	1566	2, p. 337	1248	Agenda / liturgy	L	
85	Gottesdienst-Ordnung für Meiningen	1562	2, p. 339	1248	Agenda / liturgy	L	
108	Gottesdienst-Ordnung für Meiningen	1566	2, p. 339	1248	Agenda / liturgy	L	
94	Vertrag zwischen der Hauptpfarrei Niederlauer und der Nebenpfarrei Harte	1563	2, p. 341	1249	Treaty / agreement	L	
109	Kirchen-Ordnung für Niederlauer	1566	2, p. 341	1249	Church order	L	
110	Kirchen-Ordnung für Obermaassfeld	1566	2, p. 342	1249	Church order	L	
111	Gottesdienst-Ordnung für Queienfeld	1566	2, p. 344	1249	Agenda / liturgy	L	
86	Gottesdienst-Ordnung für Ritschenhausen	1562	2, p. 345	1249	Agenda / liturgy	L	
112	Gottesdienst-Ordnung für Ritschenhausen	1566	2, p. 346	1249	Agenda / liturgy	L	
71	Ordnung der Visitatoren für die Stadt Schmalkalden	1555	2, p. 347	1249	Visitation	L	
87	Gottesdienst-Ordnung für Schmalkalden	1562	2, p. 349	1249	Agenda / liturgy	L	

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
88	Ordnung des predigamts und lektionen in der kirchen zu Suhl	1562	2, p. 350	1250	Local order	L	
113	Gottesdienst-Ordnung für Sulzfeld und Klein- Bardorf	1566	2, p. 352	1250	Agenda / liturgy	L	
89	Kirchen-Ordnung für Vachdorf	1562	2, p. 354	1250	Church order	L	
114	Kirchen-Ordnung für Wasungen	1566	2, p. 355	1250	Church order	L	

1.7.10 Mainz possessions (Eichsfeld, Erfurt, Querfurt)

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
75	Formula visitationis ecclesiae Erfurtensis	1557	2, p. 365	1251	Visitation	L	
	Formula pacificationis zu Erfurt	1580	2, p. 366	1251	Treaty / agreement	L	
139	Policei-Ordnung für Erfurt	1583	2, p. 370	1251	Discipline / police	L	
11	Deutsches Kirchenamt (Erfurt)	1525	2, p. 375	1251	Agenda / liturgy	L	

1.7.11 Imperial cities of Mühlhausen and Nordhausen

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
	Instruktion für den Superintendenten zu Mühlberg	1571	2, p. 385	1253	Consistory / synod / government	L	
30	Kirchen-Ordnung für die Dörfer der Stadt Mühlhausen und die Vogtei	1541	2, p. 388	1253	Church order	L	
35	Kirchen-Ordnung für die Dörfer der Stadt Mühlhausen	1542	2, p. 389	1253	Church order	L	
36	Kirchen-Ordnung der Stadt Mühlhausen	1542	2, p. 389	1253	Church order	L	
76	Artikel der Leipziger Predikanten für Mühlhausen	1557	2, p. 394	1254	Articles / statutes	L	
64	Polizei-Ordnung der Stadt Nordhausen	1549	2, p. 396	1254	Discipline / police	L	

1.7.12 Archbishopric of Magdeburg and Bishopric of Halberstadt

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
96	Verzeichniss der in der Visitation des Erzstifts Magdeburg aufgefundenen Mängel	1564	2, p. 403	1256	Visitation	L	
90	Visitations-Instruktion für Magdeburg	1562	2, p. 407	1256	Visitation	L	
91	Mandat Erzbischofs Sigismund von Magdeburg, betr. die Kirchendisciplin	1562	2, p. 411	1256	Mandate / decree	L	
	Consistorial-Ordnung für das Erzstift Magdeburg	1580	2, p. 414	1256	Consistory / synod / government	L	
140	Visitations-Instruktion für das Erzstift Magdeburg	1583	2, p. 418	1256	Visitation	L	
37	Kirchen-Ordnung der Stadt Burg	1542	2, p. 427	1257	Church order	L	
95	Gottesdienst-Ordnung für Hadmersleben	1563	2, p. 428	1257	Agenda / liturgy	L	
39	Kirchen-Ordnung der Gemeinde zu Halle	1543	2, p. 434	1257	Church order	L	
	Kirchenordnung der christlichen gemein zu Halle	1573	2, p. 436	1257	Church order	L	
92	Form der öffentlichen Busse zu Jüterbogk	1562	2, p. 443	1257	Agenda / liturgy	L	
9	Reformations-Artikel für Magdeburg	1524	2, p. 448	1257	Church order	L	
10	Ordnung der gemeinen kesten .... in der löblichen stadt Maydeburg	1524	2, p. 449	1257	Local order	L	
69	Etliche artikel zu notwendiger kirchenordnung gehörig, welcher sich die pfarrherr . zu Magdeburg.vereiniget u. s. w	1554	2, p. 450	1257	Church order	L	
117	Ordnung vom kirchengericht, bann, auch beruf und enturlaubung der prediger in Magdeburg	1569	2, p. 453	1257	Local order	L	
83	Bestallungsurkunde für den Superintendenten in Magdeburg	1560	2, p. 454	1257	Consistory / synod / government	L	
97	Verordnung der Visitatoren für Neuhaldensleben	1564	2, p. 456	1257	Visitation	L	
98	Ordo ceremoniarum ecclesiae Haldenslebensis	1564	2, p. 457	1257	Agenda / liturgy	L	
4	Ordnung zu Querfurt, Vom leben und wandel der pfarherrn, kirchen- und schuldiener	n.d.	2, p. 461	1257	School / university	L	
99	Ordnung der Visitatoren für Stassfurt	1564	2, p. 462	1258	Visitation	L	

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
145	Visitations-Instruktion für das Bisthum Halberstadt	1588	2, p. 466	1259	Visitation	L	
5	Christliche artikul und bericht, wie es in der kirchen zu Aschersleben. sol gehalten werden	n.d.	2, p. 473	1260	Mandate / decree	L	
	Kirchen agenda, derer sich der rath mit dem ministerio verglichen (Aschersleben)	1575	2, p. 477	1260	Agenda / liturgy	L	
74	Kirchen-Ordnung der Stadt Cochstedt	1556	2, p. 483	1260	Church order	L	
147	Kirchen-Ordnung zu Croppenstedt	1589	2, p. 484	1260	Church order	L	
100	Kirchen-Ordnung der Stadt Ermsleben	1564	2, p. 485	1260	Church order	L	
101	Verzeichniss, wie den hern pfarhern in St. Johannis das pfaramt bevohlen wird (Stadt Halberstadt)	1564	2, p. 486	1260	Consistory / synod / government	L	
40	Altarmanns-Ordnung für die Johanniskirche der Stadt Halberstadt	1543	2, p. 487	1260	Consistory / synod / government	L	
6	Ordnung, so die pfarvorwanten zu St. Johannis zu erhaltung der rechten armen .... vorgeschlagen (Stadt Halberstadt)	n.d.	2, p. 489	1260	Poor relief	L	

1.7.13 Principality of Anhalt

- **Tradition**: Lutheran; Philippist from 1590; Reformed from 1596.
- **Note**: Lutheran until Prince Johann Georg's reforms: exorcism dropped 1589/90, Reformed usages from 1596, formal Reformed confession 1606.
- **Texts by tradition**: Lutheran 27, Reformed 3, Philippist 2.

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
148	Reskript von Hans Georg von Anhalt	1590	2, p. 531	1261	Mandate / decree	PH	
151	Ausschreiben von Hans Georg von Anhalt	1599	2, p. 535	1261	Mandate / decree	R	
27	Die von Jonas für Zerbst verfasste Ordnung	1538	2, p. 544	1262	Other	L	
31	Ausschreiben der Fürsten Wolfgang, Johann, Georg und Joachim von Anhalt	1541	2, p. 547	1262	Mandate / decree	L	
55	Vollmacht für die Visitation in Anhalt	1545	2, p. 549	1262	Visitation	L	
56	Kirchen-Ordnung der Fürsten Johann, Georg und Joachim von Anhalt	1545	2, p. 549	1262	Church order	L	

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
59	Ausschreiben Johann Georg's und Joachim's von Anhalt, betr. allgemeine Landesbusse	1546	2, p. 553	1262	Mandate / decree	L	
62	Kirchen-Ordnung der Fürsten Johann und Georg von Anhalt	1548	2, p. 554	1262	Church order	L	
65	Ordnung der deutschen Gesänge in Anhalt	1551	2, p. 555	1262	Agenda / liturgy	L	
70	Verordnung des Fürsten Joachim von Anhalt, betr. Einführung von Synoden	1554	2, p. 557	1262	Consistory / synod / government	L	
77	Instruktion zur Visitation des Amtsbezirks Dessau	1557	2, p. 557	1262	Visitation	L	
84	Vollmacht und Instruktion zur Visitation für Anhalt	1560	2, p. 559	1262	Visitation	L	
93	Kirchen-Ordnung auf dem Lande in Anhalt	1562	2, p. 561	1262	Church order	L	
115	Bericht des Anhalter Superintendenten Fabricius über seine Amtsführung	1567	2, p. 564	1262	Consistory / synod / government	L	
7	Verdracht unser g. f. und herrn und des ehrbarn rats zu Cervest der ehleute haben	n.d.	2, p. 567	1262	Marriage	L	between 1545 and 1570 (editor): addressed to Superintendent Fabricius
102	Fürstlicher bevehl der kirchenlehn, stipendiaten und des examens halben in Anhalt	1565	2, p. 567	1262	School / university	L	
116	Kirchen-Ordnung des Fürsten Bernhard von Anhalt	1568	2, p. 568	1262	Church order	L	
	Polizei- und Landes-Ordnung für Anhalt	1572	2, p. 570	1262	Discipline / police	L	
	Privilegium, belangende der verstorbenen pastorum vorlassene witwen	1580	2, p. 574	1262	Poor relief	L	
138	Visitations-Instruktion für Anhalt	1582	2, p. 574	1262	Visitation	L	
144	Visitations-Instruktion für Anhalt	1587	2, p. 577	1262	Visitation	L	
146	Instructio commissariorum in potestate executionis für Anhalt	1588	2, p. 578	1262	Articles / statutes	L	
149	Ordnung für den Küster zu Törten	1594	2, p. 579	1262	Consistory / synod / government	PH	
150	Verordnung von Johann Georg von Anhalt	1596	2, p. 580	1262	Mandate / decree	R	

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
152	Kirchen-Ordnung für Anhalt	1599	2, p. 581	1262	Church order	R	
23	Bericht von Schlaginhaufen über die von ihm in Cöthen beobachtete Gottesdienst-Ordnung	1532	2, p. 582	1263	Agenda / liturgy	L	
25	Kirchen-Ordnung zu Harzgerode	1534	2, p. 586	1263	Church order	L	
	Vergleich zwischen rath und superintendenten zu Zerbst	1572	2, p. 590	1263	Consistory / synod / government	L	
66	Verdracht-Artikel zwischen uns kirchendiener zu Zervest	1551	2, p. 591	1263	Consistory / synod / government	L	
78	Vergleich zwischen den Kirchendienern zu Zerbst	1558	2, p. 592	1263	Consistory / synod / government	L	
57	Vereinbarungen des Ministeriums zu Zerbst untereinander und mit dem Rathe zu Zerbst	1545	2, p. 593	1263	Consistory / synod / government	L	
8	Ordnung, wie es mit dem gottesdienst in der kirchen gehalten wird zu Gerenrode	1541	2, p. 595	1264	Agenda / liturgy	L	dated by the editor: the order Abbess Anna sent to Prince George on 23 July 1541

1.7.14 Naumburg cathedral (supplement)

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
41	Gottesdienst-Ordnung in der Domkirche zu Naumburg	1543	2, p. 596	1265	Agenda / liturgy	L	

1.8 Volume 3: Brandenburg, Lusatia, Silesia

117 texts.

1.8.1 Electorate of Brandenburg

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.
- **Note**: Joachim II's order of 1540 kept much traditional ceremonial; the Interim was imposed in 1548, but Sehling prints no Interim order.

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
118	Rezess für die Stadt Frankfurt	1600	3, p. 22	1744	Treaty / agreement	L	
11	Neumärkische Kastenordnung	1540	3, p. 28	1745	Poor relief	L	
43	Des Markgrafen Johann Anweisung zur Kirchenvisitation in der Neumark	1551	3, p. 36	1745	Visitation	L	
12	Kirchenordnung der Mark Brandenburg	1540	3, p. 39	1746	Church order	L	
53	Ordnung und Satzung, wornach sich die patronen usw. in Brandenburg zu richten	1558	3, p. 90	1747	Local order	L	
71	Brandenburgische Kirchenordnung	1572	3, p. 94	1747	Church order	L	
74	Brandenburgische Visitations- und Consistorialordnung	1573	3, p. 105	1748	Visitation	L	

1.8.2 Lordships of Beeskow and Storkow

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
100	Mandat, betr. Einführung des Gnadenjahrs für das Domstift Cöln	1585	3, p. 142	1749	Mandate / decree	L	
75	Kirchenordnung der Markgräfin Catharina	1573	3, p. 147	1750	Church order	L	
85	Abschied für Beeskow	1570	3, p. 147	1750	Visitation	L	

1.8.3 Lands of the von der Schulenburg family

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
72	Kirchenordnung der Familie v. d. Schulenburg	1572	3, p. 149	1752	Church order	L	

1.8.4 Towns of the Mark Brandenburg

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
49	Visitations-Abschied für Angermünde	1557	3, p. 151	1753	Visitation	L	
48	Visitations-Abschied für Bagow	1553	3, p. 153	1754	Visitation	L	
13	Visitations-Abschied für die Kirchen St. Nicolai und St. Marien zu Berlin	1540	3, p. 155	1755	Visitation	L	

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
44	Visitations-Abschied für Berlin	1551	3, p. 160	1756	Visitation	L	
76	Visitationsabschied für Berlin	1574	3, p. 161	1757	Visitation	L	
19	Visitations-Rezess für die Altstadt Brandenburg	1540	3, p. 178	1758	Visitation	L	
80	Abschied für Altstadt Brandenburg	1575	3, p. 182	1758	Visitation	L	
81	Abschied für Neustadt Brandenburg	1575	3, p. 182	1758	Visitation	L	
14	Visitations-Abschied für Cöln	1540	3, p. 194	1759	Visitation	L	
20	Visitations-Abschied für Cöpenik	1540	3, p. 198	1760	Visitation	L	
86	Visitationsabschied für Cottbus	1570	3, p. 200	1761	Visitation	L	
21	Visitations-Rezess für das Benediktiner-Nonnen- Kloster Crevese	1540	3, p. 202	1762	Visitation	L	
45	Anordnungen der Visitatoren wegen der Pfarre zu Crevese	1551	3, p. 204	1763	Visitation	L	
15	Kirchenordnung für die Stadt Frankfurt	1540	3, p. 208	1764	Church order	L	
70	Agenda, colligirt und zusammengetragen durch Dr. Joachimum Goltzium	1560	3, p. 213	1765	Agenda / liturgy	L	
22	Abschied für Gardelegen	1540	3, p. 218	1766	Visitation	L	
108	Distributio concionum für Gardelegen	1590	3, p. 222	1767	Agenda / liturgy	L	
87	Constitutiones inspectoris ministrorum et pastorum villanorum in sede Garleviana	1570	3, p. 224	1768	Articles / statutes	L	
88	Visitationsordnung für Gardelegen	1570	3, p. 226	1768	Visitation	L	
40	Abschied der Visitatoren für Havelberg	1545	3, p. 227	1768	Visitation	L	
	/ *54. Visitationsordnung für Havelberg	1558	3, p. 229	1769	Visitation	L	
	I *55. Abschied für das Dorf Kleptow	1558	3, p. 235	1770	Visitation	L	
103	Gottesdienstordnung für Königsberg in der Neumark	1586	3, p. 236	1771	Agenda / liturgy	L	

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
23	Abschied für das Kloster Lehnin	1540	3, p. 238	1772	Visitation	L	
56	Abschied für Lenzen	1558	3, p. 239	1773	Visitation	L	
24	Abschied für Lychen	1540	3, p. 240	1773	Visitation	L	
25	Abschied für Osterburg	1540	3, p. 242	1773	Visitation	L	
34	Visitationsordnung der Stadt Perleberg	1542	3, p. 244	1774	Visitation	L	
57	Ordnung der Stadt Perleberg	1558	3, p. 249	1774	Local order	L	
92	Abschied für Perleberg	1581	3, p. 253	1774	Visitation	L	
26	Abschied für Potsdam	1540	3, p. 257	1775	Visitation	L	
50	Abschied für Prenzlau	1557	3, p. 261	1776	Visitation	L	
95	Vergleich der Geistlichen zu Prenzlau	1582	3, p. 262	1777	Treaty / agreement	L	
96	Ermahnung zum Opfer tür die Kirchendiener zu Prenzlau	1582	3, p. 262	1777	Consistory / synod / government	L	
97	Hospitalordnung zu Prenzlau	1582	3, p. 263	1777	Poor relief	L	
58	Abschied für Neu-Ruppin	1558	3, p. 264	1778	Visitation	L	
27	Abschied für Salzwedel-Altstadt	1540	3, p. 266	1778	Visitation	L	
28	Abschied für das Kloster St. Annen zu Salzwedel- Altstadt	1540	3, p. 272	1779	Visitation	L	
89	Abschied der Altstadt Salzwedel	1570	3, p. 272	1779	Treaty / agreement	L	
29	Abschied für Salzwedel-Neustadt	1540	3, p. 286	1779	Visitation	L	
90	Abschied der Neustadt Salzwedel	1570	3, p. 289	1780	Treaty / agreement	L	
106	Bestellung des ev. Superintendenten in Friedland 107. Begräbnissordnung für Sommerfeld	1588	3, p. 301	1781	Agenda / liturgy	L	
30	Abschied für die Pfarrkirche zu Spandau	1540	3, p. 303	1782	Visitation	L	

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
31	Visitations-Abschied für das Kloster zu Spandau	1540	3, p. 305	1783	Visitation	L	
16	Visitations-Abschied für Domstift und Domkirche zu Stendal	1540	3, p. 307	1784	Visitation	L	
17	Verordnung und Bestellung aller pfarrkirchen usw. der Stadt Stendal	1540	3, p. 309	1784	Appointment / oath	L	
32	Öffentliches Kirchengebet für den Reichstag zu Regensburg	1540	3, p. 314	1785	Agenda / liturgy	L	
46	Visitations-Abschied für Stendal	1551	3, p. 315	1786	Visitation	L	
84	Abschied für Stendal	1578	3, p. 317	1787	Visitation	L	
77	Visitationsabschied für Strausberg	1574	3, p. 332	1787	Visitation	L	
33	Ordnung für Tangermünde	1540	3, p. 334	1788	Local order	L	
91	Constitutiones sen decreta inspectoris ministrorum et pastorum paganorum in sede Tangermundensi	1580	3, p. 336	1788	Articles / statutes	L	
119	Ritus in ecclesia Tangermundensi plerique pene diu observati	1603	3, p. 338	1788	Agenda / liturgy	L	
	/ *47. Visitations-Abschied für Werben	1551	3, p. 341	1789	Visitation	L	
78	Abschied für das Dorf Wartenberg	1574	3, p. 341	1789	Visitation	L	
93	Abschied für Werben	1581	3, p. 344	1790	Visitation	L	
59	Abschied für Wusterhausen	1558	3, p. 352	1790	Visitation	L	

1.8.5 Upper and Lower Lusatia

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
1	Ausschreiben des Landvogts der Niederlausitz	n.d.	3, p. 362	1791	Mandate / decree	L	
111	Kirchenordnung des Landvogts Jaroslaw von Kolowradt, für die Niederlausitz	1592	3, p. 363	1792	Church order	L	
35	Kirchenordnung des Joachim von Bieberstein	1542	3, p. 366	1793	Church order	L	

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
104	Verordnung der Herren Johann und Abraham von Bieberstein	1587	3, p. 368	1794	Mandate / decree	L	
79	Kirchenordnung des Joachim v. d. Schulenburg für die Herrschaft Lübbenau	1574	3, p. 370	1795	Church order	L	
4	Gutachten Luthers über die Ordnung des Hans von Minkwitz für Sonnenfelde	1525	3, p. 371	1795	Mandate / decree	L	
116	Kirchenordnung für die Herrschaften Sorau und Triebei	1595	3, p. 371	1795	Church order	L	
8	Ordnung des Raths für die Altaristen zu Görlitz	1530	3, p. 375	1796	Local order	L	
67	Stadt-Statuten von Görlitz	1565	3, p. 376	1796	Discipline / police	L	
94	Ordnungsartikel der Stadt Löbau	1581	3, p. 377	1797	Discipline / police	L	
66	Kirchenordnung für Zittau	1564	3, p. 379	1798	Church order	L	
117	Kirchenordnung für Herwigsdorf bei Zittau	1595	3, p. 379	1798	Church order	L	
36	Verordnung wegen Feier des Michaelstages für Cottbus	1542	3, p. 383	1799	Mandate / decree	L	
60	Eheordnung für Cottbus	1558	3, p. 384	1799	Marriage	L	

1.8.6 Silesia

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
	152S. 7. Schul- und Kirchenordnung des Raths der Stadt Breslau	1527	3, p. 396	1803	Church order	L	
	41 Gottesdienstordnung für Breslau	1550	3, p. 400	1804	Agenda / liturgy	L	
42	Ehestatut für Breslau, um 1550	1550	3, p. 404	1807	Marriage	L	
51	Bericht über die in Breslau bestehende Ordnung	1557	3, p. 404	1807	Mandate / decree	L	
101	Seuchegebet für Breslau	1585	3, p. 405	1807	Agenda / liturgy	L	
2	Bettelordnung für Breslau	1521	3, p. 406	1807	Poor relief	L	
3	Gotteskastenordnung für Breslau	1528	3, p. 406	1807	Poor relief	L	

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
105	Gebet für die Wahl eines polnischen Königs	1587	3, p. 406	1807	Agenda / liturgy	L	
5	Instruktion und Ordnung des gemeinen Almosen zu Breslau	1526	3, p. 409	1807	Poor relief	L	
73	Ordnung der Bettler für Breslau	1572	3, p. 411	1807	Poor relief	L	
108	Breslauische Bettlerordnung	1591	3, p. 414	1807	Poor relief	L	
18	Kirchenordnung für die Stadt Neumarkt. Nach 1540	1540	3, p. 417	1807	Church order	L	
102	Almosenordnung der Stadt Breslau	1585	3, p. 418	1807	Poor relief	L	
37	Visitationsbefehl für Liegnitz	1542	3, p. 421	1808	Visitation	L	
10	Verordnung des Herzogs Friedrich für die Stadt Liegnitz	1535	3, p. 429	1809	Mandate / decree	L	
6	Des . . . fursten und herrn, Friedrichs . . . zur Liegnitz . . . Grund, ursach, und entschuldigung	1527	3, p. 430	1809	School / university	L	
9	Vergleichung des Ausschusses und folgend aller diener des hl. evangelii der Liegnitz- und Brigischen Fürstenthümer	1535	3, p. 436	1809	Treaty / agreement	L	
38	Kirchenordnung für Liegnitz-Brieg	1542	3, p. 439	1809	Church order	L	
39	Visitations-Instruktion für Brieg	1542	3, p. 441	1809	Visitation	L	
52	Mandat Georgs II. für Liegnitz-Brieg	1557	3, p. 442	1809	Mandate / decree	L	
68	Visitations-Instruktion für Liegnitz-Brieg	1565	3, p. 443	1809	Visitation	L	
61	Geschäftsordnung für den Generalkonvent in Liegnitz-Brieg. Nach 1557	1558	3, p. 444	1809	Consistory / synod / government	L	
69	Verordnung wegen des Türkengebets zu Brieg	1565	3, p. 444	1809	Agenda / liturgy	L	
112	Kirchenordnung Herzog Joachim Friedrichs zu Liegnitz und Brieg	1592	3, p. 444	1809	Church order	L	
	f63. Traubüchlein von Georg Buchholtzer. 64. Eheordnung für das Fürstenthum Jägerndorf	1561	3, p. 450	1810	Agenda / liturgy	L	
82	Berufungsurkunde für den Dechanten zu Pless	1577	3, p. 454	1812	Appointment / oath	L	
113	Kirchenordnung der Standesherren Seifried und Abraham von Promnitz für Pless	1592	3, p. 455	1813	Church order	L	

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
98	Kirchenordnung für das Fürstenthum Teschen	1584	3, p. 458	1814	Church order	L	
62	Instruktion für den Organisten zu Münsterberg	1558	3, p. 466	1816	Consistory / synod / government	L	
83	Bestätigung der an der Pfarrkirche bestehenden Bruderschaft des Bürgerchors zu Münsterberg	1577	3, p. 466	1816	Consistory / synod / government	L	
114	Zucht- und Polizeiordnung für Hirschberg	1592	3, p. 470	1819	Discipline / police	L	
65	Begräbnissordnung für Habelschwerdt	1563	3, p. 474	1821	Agenda / liturgy	L	
99	Kirchenordnung der Herrschaften Freudenthal und Goldstein	1584	3, p. 476	1823	Church order	L	
110	Kirchenordnung der Herrschaften Freudenthal und Goldstein	1590	3, p. 477	1824	Church order	L	
115	Kirchenordnung der Herrschaften Freudenthal, und Goldstein	1592	3, p. 481	1824	Church order	L	

1.9 Volume 4: Prussia, Poland, Pomerania

126 texts.

1.9.1 Duchy of Prussia

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
	Visitations-Abschied für Fischhausen (Regest)	1568	4, p. 11	1830	Visitation	L	
	Visitations-Abschied für Tromnau (Regest)	1576	4, p. 14	1830	Visitation	L	
	Visitations-Abschied für Grampten (Regest)	1576	4, p. 14	1830	Visitation	L	
	Visitations-Abschied für Krepelnau (Regest)	1577	4, p. 14	1830	Visitation	L	
	Visitations-Abschied für Marienfeld (Regest)	1578	4, p. 15	1830	Visitation	L	
	Visitations-Abschied für Mühlhausen (Regest)	1578	4, p. 15	1830	Visitation	L	
	Visitations-Abschied für Döbern (Regest)	1578	4, p. 15	1830	Visitation	L	
	Visitations-Abschied für Hohenstein (Regest)	1578	4, p. 15	1830	Visitation	L	
	Visitations-Abschied in Preussen (Regest)	1584	4, p. 17	1830	Visitation	L	
1	Themata episcopi Risenburgensis	1525	4, p. 29	1831	Confession / doctrine	L	
2	Artikel der ceremonien und anderer kirchen ordnung in Preussen	1525	4, p. 30	1832	Confession / doctrine	L	

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
3	Etliche ausgezogen artikel aus gemeiner landsordnung des herzogthums Preussen	1525	4, p. 38	1833	Other	L	
4	Visitations-Instruktion für Preussen	1526	4, p. 41	1833	Visitation	L	
5	Visitations-Instruktion für Preussen	1528	4, p. 42	1833	Visitation	L	
6	Episcopale mandatum für Preussen	1539	4, p. 45	1833	Mandate / decree	L	
7	Artikel von erwelung und underhaltung der pfarrer u. s. w. in Preussen	1540	4, p. 47	1833	Articles / statutes	L	
8	Artikel durch fürstliche durchleuchtigkeit u. s. w. bewilliget	1540	4, p. 53	1833	Articles / statutes	L	
9	Verordnung gegen abergläubische Missbrauche	1541	4, p. 56	1833	Mandate / decree	L	
10a	Bevelch zur gottesforcht u. s. w. in Preussen	1543	4, p. 57	1833	Other	L	
10b	Rundschreiben zur Vollziehung des vorstehenden Befehls	1543	4, p. 60	1833	Mandate / decree	L	
11	Eides- und Ordinations-Formulare in Preussen	1543	4, p. 61	1833	Agenda / liturgy	L	
12	Ordnung vom Gottesdienst in Preussen	1544	4, p. 61	1833	Agenda / liturgy	L	
13	Kirchenordnung in Preussen	1568	4, p. 72	1833	Church order	L	
14	Von erwehlung der beiden bischoff in Preussen	1568	4, p. 107	1833	Other	L	
15	Kirchenzucht-Mandat für Preussen	1581	4, p. 122	1833	Discipline / police	L	
16	Consistorialordnung in Preussen	1584	4, p. 123	1834	Consistory / synod / government	L	
17	Visitations-Abschied von Czichen	1581	4, p. 139	1836	Visitation	L	
18	Visitations-Abschied für die Stadt Holland	1578	4, p. 140	1836	Visitation	L	
19	Kastenordnung von Königsberg	1524	4, p. 143	1836	Poor relief	L	
20	Visitations-Abschied für Löbenicht-Königsberg	1585	4, p. 144	1836	Visitation	L	
21	Begräbnissordnung für Königsberg	1585	4, p. 145	1837	Agenda / liturgy	L	
22	Abschied für Lyck	1579	4, p. 147	1837	Visitation	L	
23	Gottesdienstordnung für Marggrabowa	1581	4, p. 149	1837	Agenda / liturgy	L	
24	Confirmation der Stadt Marienwerder	1588	4, p. 150	1838	Treaty / agreement	L	

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
25	Visitations-Abschied für Osterode	1576	4, p. 151	1839	Visitation	L	
26	Gottesdienstordnung für Sensburg	1581	4, p. 151	1839	Agenda / liturgy	L	
27	Visitations-Abschied für Soldau	1587	4, p. 152	1839	Visitation	L	
28	Visitations-Abschied für Zinten	1575	4, p. 153	1840	Visitation	L	

1.9.2 Royal Prussia: Danzig, Elbing, Thorn and their lands

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
	Entwurf einer Kirchenordnung für Danzig (Regest)	1567	4, p. 168	1844	Church order	L	
29	Armenordnung für Danzig	1525	4, p. 175	1844	Poor relief	L	
30	Armenordnung für Danzig	1551	4, p. 176	1844	Poor relief	L	
31	Kirchenordnung für Danzig	1557	4, p. 181	1844	Church order	L	
32	Köstenordnung für Danzig	1564	4, p. 181	1844	Marriage	L	
33	Gottesdienstordnung für die Marienkirche zu Danzig	1567	4, p. 186	1844	Agenda / liturgy	L	
	Entwurf einer Feiertagsordnung für Danzig um 1567 (33 Anm.)	1567	4, p. 186	1844	Discipline / police	L	
34	Kirchenordnung für Danzig	1570	4, p. 188	1844	Church order	L	
35	Chor-Ordnung für Danzig	1572	4, p. 191	1844	Agenda / liturgy	L	
36	Rathsabschied für Danzig	1573	4, p. 191	1844	Visitation	L	
37	Begräbnissordnung für Danzig	1578	4, p. 191	1844	Agenda / liturgy	L	
38	Decret des Senats von Danzig	1586	4, p. 191	1844	Mandate / decree	L	
	Köstenordnung für Danzig (39 u. 40)	1590	4, p. 192	1844	Marriage	L	
	Köstenordnung für Danzig (39 u. 40)	1595	4, p. 192	1844	Marriage	L	

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
41	Kirchenordnung für Danzig	1612	4, p. 197	1844	Church order	L	
42	Kirchenordnung für den Stüblauschen Werder	1582	4, p. 218	1844	Church order	L	
43	Kirchenordnung für Hela	1583	4, p. 220	1844	Church order	L	
44	Kirchenordnung für das Land bei Danzig	1591	4, p. 221	1844	Church order	L	
45	Bedenken für Elbing	1570	4, p. 223	1844	Mandate / decree	L	
46	(Nach 1560) Kirchenordnung für Thorn	1560	4, p. 228	1844	Church order	L	
	Ende des 16. Jahrhunderts. Gebet für den (polnischen) Landesherrn in Thorn (Regest)	1599	4, p. 228	1844	Agenda / liturgy	L	
47	Kirchenordnung für Thorn	1575	4, p. 233	1844	Church order	L	
48	Kirchenordnung für Thorn	1599	4, p. 244	1844	Church order	L	

1.9.3 Greater Poland (Posen): synods, the Bohemian Brethren and the towns

- **Tradition**: Sandomierz consensus (Lutheran, Reformed, Brethren).
- **Note**: Lutherans, Reformed and Bohemian Brethren lived side by side; the three joined in the Consensus of Sandomierz (1570), renewed by later general synods.
- **Texts by tradition**: Sandomierz consensus (Lutheran, Reformed, Brethren) 6, Lutheran 6, Reformed 3, Hussite (Bohemian Brethren) 3.

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
49	Synode von Sendomir	1570	4, p. 257	1846	Consistory / synod / government	C	
50	Synode von Posen	1570	4, p. 258	1846	Consistory / synod / government	C	
51	Synode von Krakau	1573	4, p. 260	1846	Consistory / synod / government	C	
52	Synode von Petrikau	1578	4, p. 262	1846	Consistory / synod / government	C	
53	Synode von Wladislaw	1583	4, p. 263	1846	Consistory / synod / government	C	
54	Synode von Thorn	1595	4, p. 265	1846	Consistory / synod / government	C	
55	Synode von Gostyn	1565	4, p. 268	1846	Consistory / synod / government	L	Lutheran synod of Greater Poland

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
56	Synode von Xions (A. Protokoll-Auszug)	1560	4, p. 270	1846	Consistory / synod / government	R	Little Polish Reformed, united with the Brethren
57	Synode von Xions (B. Conclusiones	1560	4, p. 271	1846	Consistory / synod / government	R	Little Polish Reformed, united with the Brethren
58	Synode von Pinczow	1561	4, p. 272	1846	Consistory / synod / government	R	Little Polish Reformed, united with the Brethren
59	Kirchenordnung der Böhmischen Brüder	1616	4, p. 273	1846	Church order	H	Order of the Unity of the Brethren (synod of Zerawitz)
60	/ Gottesdienstordnung für Fraustadt	1564	4, p. 293	1848	Agenda / liturgy	L	
61	Kirchenordnung für Fraustadt	1576	4, p. 294	1848	Church order	L	
62	Willkür für Fraustadt	1576	4, p. 296	1849	Discipline / police	L	
63	Privileg für Lasswitz	1575	4, p. 297	1850	Treaty / agreement	L	
62b	Rathsbeschluss für Fraustadt	1591	4, p. 297	1850	Mandate / decree	L	
64	Privileg für Lissa	1580	4, p. 298	1850	Treaty / agreement	H	Lissa, a centre of the Brethren
65	Privileg für Ostrorog	1569	4, p. 299	1851	Treaty / agreement	H	Ostroróg, chief congregation of the Unity

1.9.4 Duchy of Pomerania

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
	Visitationsordnung für Rehfeld (Regest)	1590	4, p. 315	1853	Visitation	L	
66	Kirchenordnung für Pommern	1535	4, p. 328	1855	Church order	L	
67	Pia ordinatio für Pommern	1535	4, p. 344	1856	Church order	L	
68	Barnim's IX. Mandat wider Veräusserung kirchlicher Güter	1540	4, p. 353	1858	Mandate / decree	L	
69	Kirchenordnung für Pommern	1542	4, p. 354	1858	Church order	L	
70	Visitations-Ordnung für Pommern	1547	4, p. 370	1859	Visitation	L	
71	Visitations-Verordnung für Pommern	1556	4, p. 371	1859	Visitation	L	

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
72	Verordnung des Herzogs Barnim von Pommern	1557	4, p. 374	1860	Mandate / decree	L	
73	Kirchenordnung von Pommern	1563	4, p. 375	1861	Church order	L	
74	Visitations-Ausschreiben für Pommern	1568	4, p. 375	1861	Visitation	L	
75	Kirchenordnung für Pommern	1560	4, p. 376	1861	Church order	L	
76	Agenda für Pommern	1560	4, p. 419	1863	Agenda / liturgy	L	
77	Consistorial-Instruktion für Pommern	1560	4, p. 480	1865	Consistory / synod / government	L	
78	Statuta synodica für Pommern	1574	4, p. 484	1867	Articles / statutes	L	
79	Leges praepositis ecclesiarum praescriptae für Pommern	1591	4, p. 492	1868	Articles / statutes	L	
80	Ohne Datum. *Forma der gemeinen Beicht in Pommern	1616	4, p. 494	1870	Other	L	
81	Visitations-Abschied für Anclam	1535	4, p. 495	1871	Visitation	L	
82	Abschied für Anclam	1572	4, p. 497	1871	Visitation	L	
83	Abschied für Barth	1536	4, p. 498	1871	Visitation	L	
84	Klosterordnung für Colberg	1586	4, p. 500	1872	Monastery / chapter	L	
85	Abschied für Gollnow	1537	4, p. 507	1875	Visitation	L	
86	Abschied für Gollnow	1595	4, p. 509	1875	Visitation	L	
87	Abschied für Greifswald	1535	4, p. 511	1876	Visitation	L	
88	Vertrag zwischen dem Herzog und der Stadt Greifswald wegen der Superintendenz	1553	4, p. 513	1877	Consistory / synod / government	L	
89	Kirchspielordnung für Lassan	1563	4, p. 515	1878	Church order	L	
90	Matrikel von Lindow	1571	4, p. 516	1878	Property / endowment	L	
91	Abschied für Pasewalk	1535	4, p. 517	1879	Visitation	L	

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
92	Abschied für Pyritz	1539	4, p. 519	1879	Visitation	L	
93	Visitationsordnung für Pyritz	1586	4, p. 519	1879	Visitation	L	
94	Visitations-Abschied für Stargard	1596	4, p. 520	1879	Visitation	L	
95	Kirchenstuhlordnung für Stargard	1596	4, p. 520	1879	Property / endowment	L	
96	Abschied für Stettin	1535	4, p. 523	1880	Visitation	L	
97	Verhandlung des Herzogs Barnim mit dem Rathe von Stettin	1539	4, p. 529	1882	Treaty / agreement	L	
98	Auszug aus der Matrikel für Stettin	1540	4, p. 529	1882	Property / endowment	L	
99	Consistorial-Beschluss für Stettin	1573	4, p. 530	1882	Consistory / synod / government	L	
100	Abschied für Stettin	1573	4, p. 531	1883	Visitation	L	
101	Abschied für Stolp	1535	4, p. 535	1884	Visitation	L	
102	Abschied für Stolp	1571	4, p. 536	1884	Visitation	L	
103	Abschied für Stolp	1590	4, p. 537	1884	Visitation	L	
104	Kirchen- und Schulordnung für Stralsund	1525	4, p. 542	1884	School / university	L	
105	Kirchen- und Schulordnung für Stralsund. Publikationsbefehl des Rathes	1525	4, p. 545	1886	School / university	L	
106	Anhang zur Stralsunder Kirchen- und Schulordnung	1525	4, p. 547	1887	School / university	L	
107	Visitationsrezess und Kirchenordnung für Stralsund	1535	4, p. 548	1887	Church order	L	
108	Entwurf einer Kirchenordnung für Stralsund	1555	4, p. 550	1888	Church order	L	
109	Stralsunder Kleider- und Hochzeitsordnung	1570	4, p. 552	1889	Marriage	L	
111	Abschied für Wollin	1535	4, p. 553	1889	Visitation	L	
110	Matrikel von Usedom	1577	4, p. 553	1889	Property / endowment	L	

1.10 Volume 5: Livonia, Estonia, Courland, Mecklenburg, Lübeck, Lauenburg, Hamburg

86 texts.

1.10.1 Livonia

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
	Verhandlungen der livländischen Städte zu Wolmar, 31. Januar	1533	5, p. 6	1897	Treaty / agreement	L	
	Gottesdienstordnung für Riga	1530	5, p. 11	1897	Agenda / liturgy	L	
	Ordnung für die St. Johannisgemeinde zu Dorpat	1550	5, p. 27	1898	Local order	L	
	Verordnung wegen des Beichtens zu Dorpat	1553	5, p. 27	1898	Agenda / liturgy	L	
	Ordnung des Raths zu Dorpat	1553	5, p. 27	1898	Local order	L	
	Ordnung des Raths zu Dorpat	1554	5, p. 29	1898	Local order	L	
	Armen-Ordnung zu Dorpat	1554	5, p. 29	1898	Poor relief	L	
	Ordnung des Raths zu Dorpat	1554	5, p. 30	1899	Local order	L	

1.10.2 Estonia (Reval)

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
	Entwurf der Prediger zu Reval	1524	5, p. 39	1901	Other	L	
	Ordnung des Raths zu Reval	1524	5, p. 40	1901	Local order	L	
	Vorschlag Langes zu Reval, betr. den Gottesdienst	1525	5, p. 40	1901	Agenda / liturgy	L	
	Ordnung des Raths zu Reval	1525	5, p. 41	1902	Local order	L	
	Ordnung des Raths zu Reval über die Einkünfte	1525	5, p. 41	1902	Local order	L	

1.10.3 Courland

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
	Kirchenreformation für Kurland	1570	5, p. 49	1904	Church order	L	
	Kirchenordnung für Kurland	1570	5, p. 66	1906	Church order	L	
	Instructio generalis für Kurland	1570	5, p. 79	1907	Other	L	
	Ausschreiben Herzog Gottfrieds für Kurland	1580	5, p. 110	1907	Mandate / decree	L	

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
	Ausschreiben Herzog Gottfrieds für Kurland	1583	5, p. 112	1908	Mandate / decree	L	
	Visitations-Rezess für Nerfft	1584	5, p. 112	1908	Visitation	L	
	Visitations-Rezess für Nerft	1591	5, p. 114	1909	Visitation	L	
	Abschied für Grobin	1560	5, p. 115	1910	Visitation	L	
	Erlass des Herzogs Albrecht in Preussen für Grobin	1561	5, p. 117	1911	Mandate / decree	L	
	Sackenhausensche Kirchenordnung	1568	5, p. 120	1911	Church order	L	
	Sackenhausensche Kirchenordnung	1586	5, p. 129	1916	Church order	L	

1.10.4 Mecklenburg

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
	Mandat der Herzöge zu Mecklenburg	1560	5, p. 137	1919	Mandate / decree	L	
	Befehl an die Bauern zu Schwichtenberg und Sandhagen	1570	5, p. 139	1919	Mandate / decree	L	
	Eid der Kirchengeschworenen in Mecklenburg	1570	5, p. 139	1919	Appointment / oath	L	
	Visitations-Instruktion für Mecklenburg	1535	5, p. 147	1920	Visitation	L	
	Verordnung der Visitatoren für Mecklenburg	1542	5, p. 148	1921	Visitation	L	
	Ordeninge der misse für Mecklenburg	1545	5, p. 150	1922	Agenda / liturgy	L	
	Kirchenordnung für Mecklenburg	1552	5, p. 161	1922	Church order	L	
	Visitations-Instruktion für Mecklenburg	1552	5, p. 219	1923	Visitation	L	
	Processus visitationis für Mecklenburg	1552	5, p. 221	1924	Visitation	L	
	Kirchenordnung für Mecklenburg	1557	5, p. 224	1925	Church order	L	
	Visitations-Instruktion für Mecklenburg	1557	5, p. 224	1925	Visitation	L	

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
	Visitations-Instruktion für Mecklenburg	1560	5, p. 227	1925	Visitation	L	
	Artikel für Mecklenburg	1567	5, p. 229	1926	Articles / statutes	L	
	Kirchengerichts- oder Consistori-Ordnung zu Mecklenburg	1570	5, p. 231	1926	Consistory / synod / government	L	
	Superintendenten-Ordnung für Mecklenburg	1571	5, p. 247	1926	Consistory / synod / government	L	
	Jungfrauen-Klosterordnung für Mecklenburg	1572	5, p. 250	1926	Monastery / chapter	L	
	Ordnung für Fürstenberg	1578	5, p. 262	1927	Local order	L	
	Ordnung für Malchin	1534	5, p. 266	1928	Local order	L	
	Ordnung für Neubrandenburg	1557	5, p. 267	1929	Local order	L	
	Ordnung für Neubrandenburg	1560	5, p. 270	1930	Local order	L	
	Ordnung des Raths für Rostock	1530	5, p. 281	1931	Local order	L	
	Ordnung für Rostock	1541	5, p. 282	1931	Local order	L	
	Visitations-Instruktion für Rostock	1557	5, p. 283	1932	Visitation	L	
	Erbvertrag für Rostock	1573	5, p. 284	1933	Treaty / agreement	L	
	Statuta etc. für Rostock	1573	5, p. 285	1934	Articles / statutes	L	
	Articuli für das Ministerium zu Rostock	1574	5, p. 286	1935	Confession / doctrine	L	
	Conformitas ceremoniarum für Rostock	1560	5, p. 288	1936	Agenda / liturgy	L	
	Artikel für Predigtamtskandidaten zu Rostock	1570	5, p. 291	1937	Articles / statutes	L	
	Visitations-Instruktion für Rostock	1578	5, p. 291	1937	Visitation	L	
	Eheordnung für Rostock	1581	5, p. 293	1938	Marriage	L	
	Erbvertrag mit Rostock	1584	5, p. 295	1938	Treaty / agreement	L	

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
	Bericht des Superintendenten Pauli zu Rostock	1585	5, p. 298	1938	Consistory / synod / government	L	
	Ehemandat für Rostock	1585	5, p. 299	1939	Marriage	L	
	Ordnung für Schwerin	1541	5, p. 300	1940	Local order	L	
	Ordnung für Wesenberg	1567	5, p. 301	1941	Local order	L	
	Ordnung für Wismar	1541	5, p. 308	1942	Local order	L	
	Ordnung des Raths zu Wismar	1543	5, p. 311	1943	Local order	L	
	Pia conjunctio zu Wismar	1562	5, p. 311	1943	Agenda / liturgy	L	
	Begräbnissordnung für Wismar	1563	5, p. 312	1944	Agenda / liturgy	L	
	Abschied für Wismar	1572	5, p. 312	1944	Visitation	L	
	Begräbnissordnung zu Wismar	1575	5, p. 314	1945	Agenda / liturgy	L	
	Visitations-Instruktion für das Stift Schwerin	1557	5, p. 316	1946	Visitation	L	
	Consistorialordnung des Stifts Schwerin	1567	5, p. 319	1947	Consistory / synod / government	L	

1.10.5 Lübeck with Bergedorf

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
	Kirchenordnung für Lübeck	1531	5, p. 334	1949	Church order	L	
	Erklärung des Raths zu Lübeck	1575	5, p. 368	1949	Mandate / decree	L	
	Senatsbeschluss von Lübeck	1579	5, p. 369	1949	Mandate / decree	L	
	Senatsbeschluss von Lübeck	1582	5, p. 370	1949	Mandate / decree	L	
	Decretum senatus zu Lübeck	1582	5, p. 372	1949	Mandate / decree	L	
	Deklaration des Raths zu Lübeck	1588	5, p. 374	1949	Mandate / decree	L	

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
	Ordnung des St. Johannisklosters zu Lübeck	1569	5, p. 375	1949	Monastery / chapter	L	
	Ordnung für das lübeckische Landgebiet	1531	5, p. 379	1950	Local order	L	
	Ordnung der Stadt Mölln	1531	5, p. 381	1950	Local order	L	
	Ordnung für Travemünde	1531	5, p. 382	1950	Local order	L	
	Kirchenordnung für Bergedorf	1544	5, p. 386	1950	Church order	L	

1.10.6 Lauenburg and the Land Hadeln

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
	Kirchenordnung für Lauenburg	1585	5, p. 397	1953	Church order	L	
	Polizeiordnung für Hadeln	1599	5, p. 464	1955	Discipline / police	L	
	Kirchenordnung für Hadeln	1542	5, p. 465	1955	Church order	L	

1.10.7 Hamburg

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
	Kirchenordnung für Hamburg	1529	5, p. 488	1957	Church order	L	
	Hamburger Artikel	1535	5, p. 540	1960	Other	L	
	Kirchenordnung für Hamburg	1556	5, p. 543	1962	Church order	L	
	Mandat des Raths zu Hamburg	1556	5, p. 556	1963	Mandate / decree	L	
	Ordnung für Ritzebüttel (nach 1570)	1570	5, p. 556	1963	Local order	L	

1.11 Volume 6/1: Lower Saxony I/1: Wolfenbüttel, Braunschweig, Lüneburg

26 texts.

1.11.1 Principality of Wolfenbüttel

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
1	Visitations-Instruktionen im Herzogtum Wolfenbüttel. 1542	1542	6/1, p. 12	1971	Visitation	L	
2	Christlike kerken-ordeninge im lande Brunschwig, Wulffenbüttels deles. 1543	1543	6/1, p. 22	1972	Church order	L	

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
3	Kirchenordnung unser, von Gottes genaden Julii, herzogen zu Braunschweig und Lüneburg etc. 1569 (Register S. 278)	1569	6/1, p. 83	1974	Church order	L	
4	Christlicher und gründlicher bericht, welcher gestalt die herrn und jungfrauenklöster im herzogthumb Braunschweig, Wulffenbütlischen theils …	1569	6/1, p. 281	1975	Monastery / chapter	L	

1.11.2 Town of Braunschweig

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
1	Der erbarn stadt Brunswig christlike ordeninge . . . Dorch Joannem Bugenhagen Pomeren bescreven. 1528	1528	6/1, p. 348	1981	Church order	L	
2	Ordnunge, wie es hinfuro mit den nominationibus, vocationibus und annhemunge der herren predicanten in den kirchen zu Braunschweig gleichformig und …	1571	6/1, p. 456	1984	Local order	L	
3	Acta inter senatum et ministerium in dimissione D. Joach. Morlini (Bestallungsordnung für M. Chemnitz). 1567	1567	6/1, p. 459	1986	Consistory / synod / government	L	
4	Articuli, qui subscribendi proponuntur illis, qui administerium in hac ecclesia recipiuntur. [1571]	1571	6/1, p. 471	1987	Confession / doctrine	L	
5	Ordnung der ceremonien auf den dorfern der stadt Braunschweigk. o.J	n.d.	6/1, p. 473	1988	Agenda / liturgy	L	
6	Artikel, in der visitation den pfarhern uberantwort	n.d.	6/1, p. 476	1989	Visitation	L	
7	Artikel, de visitation beider gerichte Asseborch und Eike belangen. [1546]	1546	6/1, p. 478	1991	Visitation	L	

1.11.3 Principality of Lüneburg

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
1	Artikel, darinne etlike mysbruke by den parren des förstendoms Lüneborg entdecket unde darjegen gude ordenynge angegeven werden . . . 1527	1527	6/1, p. 492	1995	Articles / statutes	L	
2	Wie und was wir, Ernst, von Gots gnaden herzog zu Braunswick und Leuneborg, unsers furstenthumbs pharhern und predigern zu predigen befholen. [1529]	1529	6/1, p. 522	2001	Mandate / decree	L	

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
3	Herzog Ernstes ordnung belangende der pastorn inkomen und ehesachen. [1543]	1543	6/1, p. 528	2002	Marriage	L	
4	Kirchenordnung: Wie es mit christlicher lere, reichung der sacrament, ordination der diener des evangelii, ordentlichen ceremonien, visitation …	1564	6/1, p. 533	2003	Agenda / liturgy	L	
5	Instruktionen zu den Visitationen im Fürstentum Lüneburg 1565 u. 1568	1568	6/1, p. 576	2006	Visitation	L	
6	Visitationsartikel für das Fürstentum Lüneburg. 1583	1583	6/1, p. 580	2007	Visitation	L	
7	Radtslach to nodtroft der kloster des förstendoms Lüneborch, Gades wort unde ceremonien belangen. 1530	1530	6/1, p. 586	2008	Agenda / liturgy	L	
8	Reformatio coenobiorum ducatus Luneburgensis. [1555]	1555	6/1, p. 609	2009	Church order	L	
9	Klosterordnung des Herzogs Wilhelm d. J. für das Fürstentum Lüneburg. 1574	1574	6/1, p. 619	2010	Monastery / chapter	L	
10	Emendatio Breviarii virginum ordinis Sancti Benedicti in ducatu Luneburgensi. [1555]	1555	6/1, p. 624	2011	Mandate / decree	L	

1.11.4 Town of Lüneburg

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
1	Christlyke ordenynghe van der scholen und kercken sacken der stadt Luneborch. Dorch Urbanum Rhegium. [1531]	1531	6/1, p. 633	2013	School / university	L	
2	Kirchenordnung der Stadt Lüneburg. 1575	1575	6/1, p. 650	2016	Church order	L	
3	Leges ministrorum verbi Dei in ecclesia civitatis Lunaeburgensis [ca. 1570]	1570	6/1, p. 691	2020	Articles / statutes	L	
4	Leges ad solum scribam ministrorum verbi pertinentes. [ca. 1570?]	1570	6/1, p. 694	2021	Articles / statutes	L	
5	Ordnung des gotteshauses in dem Grall. Anno 1598	1598	6/1, p. 695	2022	Local order	L	

1.12 Volume 6/2: Lower Saxony I/2: Calenberg-Göttingen, Grubenhagen, Hoya-Diepholz

26 texts.

1.12.1 Principality of Calenberg-Göttingen

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
1	[Kirchenordnung der Herzogin Elisabeth von 1542] Christliche, bestendige und in der schrift und heiligen veteren wol gegrünte verklerung und …	1542	6/2, p. 708	2028	Church order	L	
	Catechismus odder kinderlahr … [Teil II]	1542	6/2, p. 786	2036	Catechism / instruction	L	
	Christliche kirchenordnung, ceremonien und gesenge … [Teil III]	1542	6/2, p. 788	2036	Church order	L	
	Ordnung der confirmation oder firmung … [Teil IV]	1542	6/2, p. 838	2037	Agenda / liturgy	L	
2	Ordenungh vor die klosterleuth … [1542]	1542	6/2, p. 844	2037	Monastery / chapter	L	
3	Instructio, was die verordenten visitatores in der durchleuchtigen und hochgebornen furstinnen und frauen, frauen Elisabet, … herzogin zu Brunsweig …	1542	6/2, p. 855	2037	Visitation	L	
4	Artikel, den gemeinen kasten belangent [1542]	1542	6/2, p. 861	2038	Articles / statutes	L	
5	Reformation, gesetz und statuten unser, von Gotts gnaden Elisabet, … herzogin zu Braunschweigk und Luneburgk etc., witwen, so wir zu nutz, gedeien …	1542	6/2, p. 862	2038	Church order	L	
6	Constitutiones aliquot synodales, das ist, etliche satzunge, so in zweien geistlichen versamlungen, deren eine zu Pattensen im	1544	6/2, p. 866	2038	Articles / statutes	L	
7	Visitatio generalis ducatus Calenbergici anno 1588	1588	6/2, p. 878	2040	Visitation	L	
8	Landtagsabschied, so zwischen dem hochwürdigen, durchleuchtigen hochgebornen fürsten und herrn, herrn Heinrichen Julio, … herzogen zu Braunschweig …	1601	6/2, p. 890	2042	Treaty / agreement	L	
9	Reformation und Ordnung des Stifts Wunstorf … 1598	1598	6/2, p. 896	2042	Church order	L	

1.12.2 Town of Göttingen

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
1	Christlike ordeninge der stadt Gottingen … 1531	1531	6/2, p. 906	2044	Church order	L	
2	Christliche und in Gottes wort, altem und neuem testament. gegründte kirchenordnung der stadt Göttingen … 1568	1568	6/2, p. 916	2044	Church order	L	

1.12.3 Town of Northeim

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
	Kirchenordnung der löblichen stadt Northeim, . . . gestellet durch D. Anto. Corvinum [1539]	1539	6/2, p. 922	2046	Church order	L	

1.12.4 Town of Hannover

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
	Kirchenordnung der statt Hannofer durch D. Urbanum Regium ... 1536	1536	6/2, p. 944	2049	Church order	L	

1.12.5 Principality of Grubenhagen

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
1	Kirchenordnung für das Fürstentum Grubenhagen aus dem Jahre 1538	1538	6/2, p. 1028	2055	Church order	L	
2	Reformatio, das ist fürstliche braunschweigische kirchenordenung des durchleuchtigen hochgebornen fürsten und hern, hern Philips, herzogen zu ...	1544	6/2, p. 1031	2056	Church order	L	
3	Visitatio de anno 1544 zu Einbeck, Gruben und im gericht Soltderhelden	1544	6/2, p. 1040	2057	Visitation	L	
4	Des durchlauchtigen, hochgebornen fürsten und herren, herrn Wolffgangen, herzogen zu Braunschweig und Lüneburgk etc. christliche ordnung und befehl ...	1581	6/2, p. 1041	2058	Visitation	L	
5	Christlicher abscheid deß durchleuchtigen und hochgebornen fürsten und herrn, herrn Philipsen, herzogen zu Brunschweig, anno 1583 seinen predigern ...	1583	6/2, p. 1103	2058	Other	L	
6	Instruktion zur Abhaltung von Synode und Kirchengericht, gegeben von Herzog Wolfgang, Herzog zu Braunschweig und Lüneburg, Grubenhagenschen Teils, am ...	1582	6/2, p. 1107	2058	Consistory / synod / government	L	
7	Officium superintendentis Grubenhagici. [1600]	1600	6/2, p. 1109	2058	Consistory / synod / government	L	

1.12.6 Town of Einbeck

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
	Ordnung des Herzogs Philipps I. für die Stifter St. Alexandri und B. M. V. in Einbeck. 1543	1543	6/2, p. 1114	2060	Local order	L	

1.12.7 Counties of Hoya and Diepholz

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
1	Kirchenordnung, wie es in religionssachen mit der seligmachenden lehr des heiligen göttlichen worts, christlicher administration der hochwirdigen …	1581	6/2, p. 1128	2064	Church order	L	
2	Instruction, was sich unsere, von Gotts gnaden Wilhelmen des jungern, herzogen zu Braunschweig und Luneburg, rethe, kanzler und lieben, getreuen … …	1571	6/2, p. 1204	2065	Mandate / decree	L	

1.13 Volume 7/1: Lower Saxony II/1: Bremen (archbishopric), Verden, Osnabrück, East Frisia

47 texts.

1.13.1 Archbishopric of Bremen

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
1	Agenda Wursatorum ecclesiastica offte handbook unde ordeninge der hilligen kerken im lande to Wursten …1574	1574	7/1, p. 16	2072	Agenda / liturgy	L	
2	Reformation und ordnung, so wir, von Gottes gnaden Heinrich, postulirter erzbischoff zu Bremen, administrator der stifte Oßnabrugk und Paderborn … …	1580	7/1, p. 18	2072	Church order	L	
3	[Vörder] Kirchenordnung. [1582]	1582	7/1, p. 25	2073	Church order	L	
4	Unsere, eines erwirdigen bremischen tumbcapittels, erneuerte ordenung, wie es im flecken Vorde hinfüro mit den hochzeiten, kindelbieren und …	1587	7/1, p. 28	2073	Marriage	L	
5	Visitationsankündigung für das Land Kehdingen und für Osten 1588	1588	7/1, p. 30	2074	Visitation	L	
6	Visitationsanordnung für die Dompropstei 1593	1593	7/1, p. 32	2075	Visitation	L	
7	Ordnung eins consistorii. [um 1616]	1616	7/1, p. 33	2076	Consistory / synod / government	L	

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
8	Von Gottes gnaden unser, Johan Friedrichs, erwelten und postulierten zue erz- und bischoffen dero stifter Bremen und Lübeck … verordnung, wie es …	1614	7/1, p. 39	2076	Monastery / chapter	L	

1.13.2 Town of Stade

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
	Kirchenordnung in der stadt Stade. [ca. 1620/22]	1620	7/1, p. 50	2078	Church order	L	

1.13.3 Town of Buxtehude

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
1	Angenamen kerkenordeninge eynes erbarn rades der statt Buxtehude, gestellet dorch den erwerdigen, hochgelarten Doctorem Johannem Epinum …	1552	7/1, p. 68	2081	Church order	L	
2	Buxtehuder Agende 1565	1565	7/1, p. 92	2082	Agenda / liturgy	L	

1.13.4 Bishopric of Verden

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
	Kirchenordnung, wie es mit christlicher lehr und ceremonien, verreichung der h[eiligen], hoch[wirdigen] sacramenten und andern kirchensachen im stift …	1606	7/1, p. 145	2086	Church order	L	

1.13.5 Bishopric of Osnabrück

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
1	Kerckenordnunge vor de landkercken des stifts Osenbrugge, uffgerichtet und verordnet a r[everendissi]mo et ill[ustrissi]mo d[omino], d[omino] …	1543	7/1, p. 222	2095	Church order	L	
2	Verordnung von Burgmännern und Rat zu Quakenbrück zur Einführung der Kirchenordnung des Bonnus 1543	1543	7/1, p. 227	2097	Church order	L	

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
3	Ordinatio Magistri Hermanni Bonni. Exercitium quotidianum in sacris scripturis et psalmis cantandis pro ecclesiis collegiatis... Anno 1543	1543	7/1, p. 229	2097	Church order	L	

1.13.6 Town of Osnabrück

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
1	Christliche kerkenordenunge der stadt Oßenbrugk. Anno Domini 1543	1543	7/1, p. 247	2099	Church order	L	
2	Agenda, das ist: Kirchenordnung, wie es in den evangelischen kirchen der statt Oßnabrück... sol gehalten werden. ..1618	1618	7/1, p. 265	2099	Church order	L	
3	Superattendentenordnung eins erbarn rats der statt Oßnabrügk. [1596]	1596	7/1, p. 290	2101	Consistory / synod / government	L	
4	Superintendenten- und Predigerordnung 1610	1610	7/1, p. 296	2102	Consistory / synod / government	L	
5	Armenordnung der Stadt Osnabrück 1573(?)/1587	1587	7/1, p. 301	2102	Poor relief	L	

1.13.7 East Frisia: comital orders

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.
- **Note**: The counts' orders of 1529 and 1535 are Lutheran; under Countess Anna (1540-1561) and John a Lasco East Frisia was mixed, with Emden Reformed and much of the country Lutheran.
- **Texts by tradition**: Lutheran 5, Moderate Reformed 1.
- **Interim**: 1 text(s) tied to the Augsburg Interim (see the last column).

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
	Ostfriesische Interimsordnung, 16. Juli 1549 (printed in the editor's introduction, n. 51)	1549	7/1, p. 328	2105	Church order	L	**Interim order**
1	Ordenunge und articule, so wy, Enno, grave und herr to Oestfreeslandt etc.,in unsen landen allen predicanten und underdanen gebaden hebben, ernstlick ...	1529	7/1, p. 360	2106	Church order	L	
2	Karckenordenynge vor dem pastoren unde kerckendenern ... [1535]	1535	7/1, p. 373	2107	Church order	L	
	Volget, wes de Luinenborger predicanten, belangende des superattendenten und der	n.d.	7/1, p. 383	2107	Consistory / synod / government	L	

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
	predicanten, wo de schoelen geschickt und wat eer ampt sy						
	Wo de beiden graven to Oestfreeslandt umtrent 20 articulen up de ordinantie ... hebben in allen karcken der gravesscup Oestfreeslandt publiceren ...	1535	7/1, p. 393	2107	Church order	L	
3	Polizeiordnung der Gräfin Anna 1545	1545	7/1, p. 398	2108	Discipline / police	MR	Countess Anna; John a Lasco superintendent 1543-1549

1.13.8 East Frisia: treaties

- **Tradition**: Reformed and Lutheran (treaty).
- **Note**: Settlements between the Lutheran count and Reformed Emden.

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
4	Delfzijlischer Vergleich 1595	1595	7/1, p. 414	2109	Treaty / agreement	R/L	
5	Die Konkordaten 1599	1599	7/1, p. 419	2110	Treaty / agreement	R/L	

1.13.9 East Frisia: Reformed orders of limited range (Norden, Emden, Leer, Lütetsburg; London)

- **Tradition**: Reformed.

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
6	Dese nabeschrevene manier wert geholden to Norden alle Sondaechs na dat sermoen. [ca. 1528]	1528	7/1, p. 431	2111	Other	R	
7	Acta coetus pastorum ecclesiarum Frisiae Orientalis Embdae convenientium anno 76,13. die mensis Iunii	n.d.	7/1, p. 434	2111	Consistory / synod / government	R	
8	Ordinatio coetus Leerani... [1583]	1583	7/1, p. 440	2112	Church order	R	
9	Ordnunge der vorsamlinge der predicanten und olderlingen... [vermutlich 1564/73]	1564	7/1, p. 452	2113	Local order	R	
10	Eine ordeninge der bedeleren, van den dieneren der gemeinte unde den vorstenderen, oldesten und dyaken binnen Embden utgebrocht... 1576	1576	7/1, p. 455	2113	Consistory / synod / government	R	
	Ausführungsbestimmungen 1577-1579	1579	7/1, p. 460	2113	Other	R	
11	Articulen der ordninge, darna man sich in die bieenkompsten der hueßitten diaconen richten sall etc. [ca. 1577/78]	1577	7/1, p. 464	2113	Articles / statutes	R	

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
12	Vormaninge vör und na der bedeninge des nachtmals in der kercken edder gemeine Christi in Embden. [1576]	1576	7/1, p. 466	2113	Agenda / liturgy	R	
13	Articulen, darup Pauwel Hanssen tom organisten ein jair lank angenomen. Ao. 77 am 2. Octob	n.d.	7/1, p. 475	2113	Articles / statutes	R	
14	Summarische beschryvinge der ordnung in der christlicken kercken to Embden... [1594]	1594	7/1, p. 480	2113	Church order	R	
15	Ordnüng der dueitschen schoelen und der franzosischer schoelen. [1582]	1582	7/1, p. 514	2113	School / university	R	
16	Schulordnung der stadt Embden... 1596	1596	7/1, p. 517	2113	School / university	R	
17	Eheordnung, wo idt mit dem hilligen ehestand und allem, wat dem angehorich... in der stadt Embden soll geholden werden... 1596	1596	7/1, p. 527	2114	Marriage	R	
18	Kerckenordnüng in der gemene up dem huse Lutzborch. [1606]	1606	7/1, p. 537	2115	Church order	R	
19	Kirchenordnung, wie die unter dem christlichen könig auß Engelland Edward dem VI. in der statt Londen in der niderlendischen gemeine Christi	1565	7/1, p. 579	2116	Church order	R	London Dutch stranger church (a Lasco, Micron)

1.13.10 East Frisia and Harlingerland: Lutheran orders of limited range

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
20	Armenordnung für Stadt und Kirchspiel Aurich 1578	1578	7/1, p. 668	2117	Poor relief	L	
21	Liturgia Engerhovana ... Formulae baptizandi et administrandi s. coenam pro ecclesia Engerhovensi anno 1583 adornatae per Johannem Ligarium	1583	7/1, p. 671	2118	Agenda / liturgy	L	
22	Marienhafer Kirchenordnung 1593	1593	7/1, p. 683	2119	Church order	L	
23	Kirchenordnung der graff- und herrschaften Hoya, Rittpergh, Bruchausen, Esenß, Stedeßdorff und Wittmundt, 1574	1574	7/1, p. 725	2122	Church order	L	

1.14 Volume 7/2.1: Lower Saxony II/2.1: Hildesheim, Oldenburg, Jever

37 texts.

1.14.1 Bishopric of Hildesheim (Steuerwald and Peine)

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
1	Artickel den pfarherrn an beiden gerichten Stürwald und Pein ... vorzuhalten [1560]	1560	7/2.1, p. 767	2128	Articles / statutes	L	
2	Kirchenordnunge in baiden gerichten, Steurwoldt unde Peine [1561]	1561	7/2.1, p. 769	2129	Church order	L	
3	Eid und obligation der prediger im herzogtumb Schleswiegk wie auch in ihren fürstl. gn. pfandgericht und ampt Peina [1574/89]	1574	7/2.1, p. 787	2130	Appointment / oath	L	

1.14.2 Town of Hildesheim

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
1	Christlike kerckenordeninge der löffliken stadt Hildenssem. Mit einer vörrede Antonii Coruini [1544]	1544	7/2.1, p. 829	2136	Church order	L	
2	Up dem ebrock und ander horerye umegelesen (1543)	1543	7/2.1, p. 885	2138	Marriage	L	
3	Artikel, von den Angehörigen der Stifter und Klöster zu beschwören [1546]	1546	7/2.1, p. 887	2138	Articles / statutes	L	
4	Ordnunge, wie es mit den frauwenstulen in der kirchen Sanct Pauli hinforder sol gehalten werden, 1551	1551	7/2.1, p. 893	2138	Local order	L	
5	Geholdener radtschlag uff die heimliche ehevorleubnuß, unzugt und wuecher [1562]	1562	7/2.1, p. 895	2138	Marriage	L	
6	Bestallung des organisten Seuerini Krossenn auf 10 jaren (1571)	1571	7/2.1, p. 899	2138	Consistory / synod / government	L	
7	Bestallung des Organisten Severus Kroschen, 1581	1581	7/2.1, p. 901	2138	Consistory / synod / government	L	
8	Eines erbaren rats der stad Hildeßheimb revidirte und verbesserte schuelordnung, 1574	1574	7/2.1, p. 903	2138	School / university	L	
9	Ratschlag uber alle kastenhern [1583]	1583	7/2.1, p. 925	2138	Poor relief	L	
10	Erziehung der jugend anordnung [1584]	1584	7/2.1, p. 927	2138	Mandate / decree	L	
11	Einhelliger radtslag auf das ministerium und vormeretes consistorium in matrimonialsachen [1589]	1589	7/2.1, p. 929	2138	Consistory / synod / government	L	

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
12	Eheordnung 1592	1592	7/2.1, p. 936	2138	Marriage	L	
13	Bestallung M. Henrici Heshusii (1593)	1593	7/2.1, p. 937	2138	Appointment / oath	L	
14	Ordnünge dero stadt Hildesheimb mit dem brantwein auf die Sontage wie auch mit dem schießen und wegen der hochzeit, 1597	1597	7/2.1, p. 941	2138	Marriage	L	

1.14.3 County of Oldenburg

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
1	Kirchenordnung, wie es mit der reinen lere göttliches worts ... in der löblichen graffschaft Oldenburg ... gehalten werden (Jena 1573)	1573	7/2.1, p. 986	2146	Church order	L	
2	Kirchenordnung und wie sich die gemeine unter der predig und sonsten verhalten soll, 1574	1574	7/2.1, p. 1163	2151	Church order	L	
3	Bestallunge deß superintendenten, 1574	1574	7/2.1, p. 1164	2151	Consistory / synod / government	L	
4	Fundatio des armenhauses bey S. Gertruden ... vor Olldenburg, 1581	1581	7/2.1, p. 1165	2151	Poor relief	L	
5	Vorrede zum Oldenburger Katechismus 1599	1599	7/2.1, p. 1168	2151	Catechism / instruction	L	
6	Policeyordnung wegen der hochzeiten, kindtaufen, begrabnissen, kirchgäng und kirchmessen, 1606	1606	7/2.1, p. 1172	2151	Agenda / liturgy	L	
7	Articuli der oldenburgischen kirchenvisitation, 1609	1609	7/2.1, p. 1175	2151	Confession / doctrine	L	
8	Visitationsabschiede 1609-1611	1609	7/2.1, p. 1196	2151	Visitation	L	
9	Mandata, belangent die hochzeiten, kindtauften und kirchgenge alhier zue Delmenhorst [1601]	1601	7/2.1, p. 1213	2152	Mandate / decree	L	

1.14.4 Lordship of Jever

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
10	Kirchenordnung des Fräulein Maria von Jever. Fragment, undated	n.d.	7/2.1, p. 1215	2152	Church order	L	
11	Kirchenzucht- und Polizeiordnung des Fräulein Maria von Jever, undated	n.d.	7/2.1, p. 1220	2152	Discipline / police	L	
12	Von heimlichen vorlöbniße und von wundarzten des ersten vorbands [1558]	1558	7/2.1, p. 1223	2152	Other	L	
13	Kerckenordeninge … van der eddelen unde wolgebarn Maria … to Jheuer … corrigert dorch M. Petrum Rodtbart (1562)	1562	7/2.1, p. 1225	2152	Church order	L	
14	Leges generales novae scholae Ieverensis (Wittenberg 1573)	1573	7/2.1, p. 1246	2152	Articles / statutes	L	
15	Mandatum von überflüßigen süfen in kirchgangen, haußberungen, stoel-, kinder- und trostelbiere [1574]	1574	7/2.1, p. 1251	2152	Mandate / decree	L	
16	Mandatum wegen guter kirchendisciplin, so die predigern vermöge der kirchenordnung vor die zuhörern … halten [1574]	1574	7/2.1, p. 1254	2152	Church order	L	
17	Wegen der hochzeit, kindelbiern, kirchgängen, kirchmeßen, gesellschaften und beysammendenkunften [1582]	1582	7/2.1, p. 1256	2152	Marriage	L	
18	Mandatum wegen ehebrecherey, hurerey, unzucht und heimlichen verlöbnißen [1585]	1585	7/2.1, p. 1260	2152	Mandate / decree	L	
19	Von den armen und bettlern [1596]	1596	7/2.1, p. 1263	2152	Poor relief	L	
20	Currendeordnung de dato 23ten Augusti 1596	1596	7/2.1, p. 1265	2152	Other	L	

1.15 Volume 7/2.2: Lower Saxony II/2.2: Schaumburg, Goslar, Bremen (city)

98 texts.

1.15.1 County of Schaumburg

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
1	Übergabe der Mecklenburgischen Kirchenordnung an die Pfarrer 5. Mai 1559	1559	7/2.2, p. 53	2159	Church order	L	
2	Einschärfung der Kirchenordnung 10. Mai 1560	1560	7/2.2, p. 55	2160	Church order	L	
3	Befehl zur Inventarisierung der Pfarreien und ihrer Kirchengüter 9. Juni 1562	1562	7/2.2, p. 57	2161	Mandate / decree	L	
4	Weisung an die Konvente in Fischbeck und Obernkirchen zur Beachtung der	1562	7/2.2, p. 59	2162	Church order	L	

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
	Kirchenordnung und zur Abstellung der Messe und anderer Zeremonien 22. …						
5	Einführung einer Betmesse am Freitag 20. Februar 1563	1563	7/2.2, p. 61	2163	Agenda / liturgy	L	
6a	Berufung und Instruktion der Visitatoren 21. April 1564	1564	7/2.2, p. 62	2163	Visitation	L	
6b	Anweisungen für die Durchführung der Visitation 21. April 1564	1564	7/2.2, p. 63	2163	Visitation	L	
7	Instruktion für die Visitatoren des Stifts Obernkirchen 8. Dezember 1564	1564	7/2.2, p. 64	2164	Visitation	L	
8	Fragen bei der Visitation des Stifts Obernkirchen [um den 8. Dezember 1564]	1564	7/2.2, p. 67	2165	Visitation	L	
9	Zuchtmandat 24. Februar 1570	1570	7/2.2, p. 70	2166	Discipline / police	L	
10	Garantie des Fortbestands des Stifts Möllenbeck [6. Mai 1570]	1570	7/2.2, p. 72	2167	Monastery / chapter	L	
11	Zuchtmandat 28. April 1576	1576	7/2.2, p. 76	2168	Discipline / police	L	
12	Mandat zur Erhaltung der Kirchengüter und zur jährlichen Rechnungslegung 6. Juli 1577	1577	7/2.2, p. 77	2169	Mandate / decree	L	
13	Mandat zur Feier des Tages der Conversio Pauli 19. Januar 1587	1587	7/2.2, p. 78	2170	Mandate / decree	L	
14	Verordnung zu den Eheverlöbnissen [1594]	1594	7/2.2, p. 79	2171	Marriage	L	
15	Vereinbarung für das Stift Fischbeck 27. Oktober 1602	1602	7/2.2, p. 81	2172	Monastery / chapter	L	
16	Anweisungen für die Visitation des Stifts Obernkirchen 28. Januar 1603	1603	7/2.2, p. 84	2173	Visitation	L	
17	Ordnung für das Stift Obernkirchen 6. August 1603	1603	7/2.2, p. 87	2174	Monastery / chapter	L	
18	Mandat zu den Kirchenstühlen 1603	1603	7/2.2, p. 91	2175	Mandate / decree	L	
19	Anweisung an die beiden Superintendenten zu verschiedenen Gegenständen 4. März 1609	1609	7/2.2, p. 93	2176	Consistory / synod / government	L	
20	Hausordnung für das Stift Möllenbeck 5. August 1612	1612	7/2.2, p. 95	2177	Monastery / chapter	L	
21	Kirchenordnung 1614	1614	7/2.2, p. 99	2178	Church order	L	
22	Von der Taufe unehelicher Kinder [vor 29. Juli] 1615	1615	7/2.2, p. 168	2179	Agenda / liturgy	L	

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
23	Anweisung an den Superintendenten zur neuen Kirchenordnung und zu den Kirchenrechnungen [nach 29. Juli 1615]	1615	7/2.2, p. 169	2180	Church order	L	
24	Weisungen zum Besuch der Gottesdienste und zur Heiligung Gottes 1615	1615	7/2.2, p. 171	2181	Agenda / liturgy	L	

1.15.2 Imperial city of Goslar

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.
- **Interim**: 2 text(s) tied to the Augsburg Interim (see the last column).

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
1	Die „Articuli Jacobitarum“ 18. März 1528	1528	7/2.2, p. 223	2185	Confession / doctrine	L	
2	Bericht der Stadt Nürnberg für den Goslarer Rat über die reformatorischen Änderungen in Nürnberg [30. März 1528]	1528	7/2.2, p. 227	2186	Mandate / decree	L	
3	Gottesdienstordnung: Vom teglichen gots dinst [nach 8. März 1528]	1528	7/2.2, p. 236	2187	Other	L	
4	Ordnung der Gottesdienstzeiten für die Goslarer Pfarreien 24. April 1528	1528	7/2.2, p. 239	2188	Agenda / liturgy	L	
5	Gottesdienstordnung: Kyrchenordenung der stadt Goslar [1528/29]	1528	7/2.2, p. 241	2189	Other	L	
6	Beschluß des Rates, der Gilden und Meinheit, den Gottesdienst in den Stifts- und Klosterkirchen zu meiden 28. August 1529	1529	7/2.2, p. 243	2190	Agenda / liturgy	L	
7	Kirchenordnung [nach 24. Februar] 1531	1531	7/2.2, p. 244	2191	Church order	L	
8	Beschluß zum Festhalten an der Reformation [13. März 1531]	1531	7/2.2, p. 253	2192	Mandate / decree	L	
9	Verpflichtungserklärung eines nach Wittenberg entsandten Studenten 24. Juni 1533	1533	7/2.2, p. 257	2193	Appointment / oath	L	
10a	Bestallungsurkunde für den Superintendenten Eberhard Widensee 8. September 1533	1533	7/2.2, p. 258	2193	Consistory / synod / government	L	
10b	Revers des Superintendenten 2. Februar 1534	1534	7/2.2, p. 260	2193	Consistory / synod / government	L	
10c	Neuer Revers des Superintendenten 3. Juni 1540	1540	7/2.2, p. 261	2193	Consistory / synod / government	L	

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
11	Ordnung für das Stundengebet am Stift St. Simon und Judas [1534/35]	1534	7/2.2, p. 262	2194	Agenda / liturgy	L	
12	Unterhaltung der Prädikanten und Lehrer aus dem Gemeinen Kasten 1537	1537	7/2.2, p. 266	2195	Poor relief	L	
13	Zuchtordnung 16. Dezember 1537	1537	7/2.2, p. 269	2196	Discipline / police	L	
14	Versorgungszusage für verarmte Söhne und Töchter früherer Stifter 3. November 1539	1539	7/2.2, p. 273	2197	Other	L	
15	Ordnung für das Frauenkloster Frankenberg 1542	1542	7/2.2, p. 275	2198	Monastery / chapter	L	
16a	Eingabe der Prädikanten zu den Klöstern und Stiften 18. Juli 1544	1544	7/2.2, p. 279	2198	Monastery / chapter	L	
16b	Stellungnahme des Rates zur Eingabe der Prädikanten 30. März 1545	1545	7/2.2, p. 287	2198	Other	L	
17	Im Auftrag des Rates verfaßte Stellungnahme der Prädikanten zum Interim [14. Juli 1548]	1548	7/2.2, p. 290	2199	Other	L	**On the Interim**
18	Die „Neue Ordnung“ 25. September 1548	1548	7/2.2, p. 293	2200	Other	L	**Interim year (civic order)**
19	Einigung zwischen dem Rat und den Prädikanten wegen der Versorgung der Witwen und Kinder 26. März 1550	1550	7/2.2, p. 301	2201	Poor relief	L	
20	Berufung von Tilemann Heshusen zum Superintendenten 23. März 1553	1553	7/2.2, p. 302	2202	Consistory / synod / government	L	
21	Visitationsordnung 1. Juni 1554	1554	7/2.2, p. 304	2203	Visitation	L	
22	Konsistorialordnung 1555/[nach 1561]	1561	7/2.2, p. 306	2204	Consistory / synod / government	L	
23	Bestätigung des Rates über die ihm von den Stiftsherren von St. Sixtus und Judas eingeräumte Verwendung von vier Präbenden 25. März 1555	1555	7/2.2, p. 317	2204	Monastery / chapter	L	
24a	Neugestaltung des Gottesdienstes im Stift St. Simon und Judas 1560	1560	7/2.2, p. 319	2204	Agenda / liturgy	L	
24b	Neugestaltung des Gottesdienstes der Stifte St. Simon und Judas und St. Peter August 1566	1566	7/2.2, p. 322	2204	Agenda / liturgy	L	
25	Vergleich zur Versorgung der Witwen und Kinder der verstorbenen Geistlichen 7. August 1566	1566	7/2.2, p. 324	2205	Poor relief	L	

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
26	Ordnung für das Spital St. Pankratius (Siechenhof) 24. Juni 1588	1588	7/2.2, p. 326	2206	Poor relief	L	
27	Disziplinarmandat 22. Februar 1595	1595	7/2.2, p. 338	2207	Mandate / decree	L	
28	Verzeichnis der in Goslar gültigen Lehrschriften 11. Mai 1595	1595	7/2.2, p. 339	2208	Confession / doctrine	L	
29	Vertrag zwischen dem Rat der Stadt Goslar und dem Kapitel des Stifts St. Simon und Judas Mai 1605	1605	7/2.2, p. 341	2209	Monastery / chapter	L	
30	Mandat zum pünktlichen Erscheinen beim Kirchgang der Brautleute 1612	1612	7/2.2, p. 343	2210	Mandate / decree	L	
31	Vertrag zwischen dem Rat der Stadt Goslar und dem Kapitel des Stifts St. Simon und Judas Januar 1617	1617	7/2.2, p. 344	2211	Monastery / chapter	L	

1.15.3 City of Bremen

- **Tradition**: Lutheran; Philippist from 1562; Reformed from 1580.
- **Note**: Lutheran from 1525; the dispute over Albert Hardenberg, a pupil of Melanchthon (1556-1562), led to a Philippist church (1562-1579) and from 1580 to the 'Second Reformation'.
- **Texts by tradition**: Lutheran 16, Reformed 13, Philippist 9.

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
1	Evangelische Messe 1525	1525	7/2.2, p. 403	2216	Agenda / liturgy	L	
2	Einrichtung eines Armenkastens in der Liebfrauenkirche 16. April 1525	1525	7/2.2, p. 408	2217	Poor relief	L	
3a	Vereinbarung zwischen Erzbischof Christoph und der Stadt Bremen 23. September 1533	1533	7/2.2, p. 409	2217	Treaty / agreement	L	
3b	Vertrag zwischen Erzbischof Christoph und der Stadt Bremen 22. September 1534	1534	7/2.2, p. 412	2217	Treaty / agreement	L	
4a	Ordnung der Gottesdienstzeiten für die Goslarer Pfarreien 24. April 1528: Kirchenordnung 1534	1534	7/2.2, p. 416	2217	Church order	L	
4b	Annahme der Kirchenordnung durch den Rat der Stadt Bremen. Mandat gegen die Sakramentsschänder 1534	1534	7/2.2, p. 484	2217	Church order	L	
5	Almosenordnung [nach 1534]	1534	7/2.2, p. 487	2218	Poor relief	L	
6	Vergleich des Rates mit dem Kapitel des Stifts St. Wilhadi wegen der Verwendung der Präbenden 18. Mai 1545	1545	7/2.2, p. 490	2219	Monastery / chapter	L	

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
7	Zuchtordnung 1546	1546	7/2.2, p. 493	2220	Discipline / police	L	
8	Durchführung der Visitationen in den Landgemeinden 1551	1551	7/2.2, p. 497	2221	Visitation	L	
9a	Vom Rat geforderte Erklärung der Bremer Prediger zum Abendmahl 21. Oktober 1556	1556	7/2.2, p. 499	2221	Agenda / liturgy	L	
9b	Erklärung des Dompredigers Albert Hardenberg zum Abendmahl 9. November 1556	1556	7/2.2, p. 503	2221	Agenda / liturgy	PH	Hardenberg
10	Mandat des Rates zum Verhalten der Bürger, nachdem der Streit zwischen Albert Hardenberg und den Bremer Predigern durch den Niedersächsischen Kreis …	1561	7/2.2, p. 505	2221	Mandate / decree	L	
11a	Ordnung für das Stundengebet am Stift St. Simon und Judas [1534/35]: Kirchenordnung [nach 10. Oktober] 1561	1561	7/2.2, p. 506	2221	Church order	L	
11b	Anfage der Wittheit an das Ministerium zu bestimmten Teilen der Kirchenordnung [November] 1561	1561	7/2.2, p. 518	2221	Church order	L	
11c	Stellungnahme der Prediger zu den Anfragen der Wittheit [November oder Dezember] 1561	1561	7/2.2, p. 520	2221	Other	L	
11d	Beschluß des Rates zu verschiedenen Artikeln der Kirchenordnung [Dezember 1561]	1561	7/2.2, p. 530	2221	Church order	L	
11e	Entscheidung des Rates zum Artikel über die Binde- und Lösegewalt der Prediger in der Kirchenordnung [vor 3. Januar 1562]	1562	7/2.2, p. 533	2221	Church order	PH	
12	Erlaß des Rates zu den Sakramentierern 3. Januar 1562	1562	7/2.2, p. 537	2222	Discipline / police	PH	
13	Mandat zur Enthaltung aller Streitigkeiten in Religionsangelegenheiten [Januar 1562]	1562	7/2.2, p. 539	2223	Mandate / decree	PH	
14	Mandat zum Verbot des Scheltens auf der Kanzel und zur Predigt und Lehre gemäß der Heiligen Schrift und der Confessio Augustana [24. August 1562]	1562	7/2.2, p. 540	2223	Mandate / decree	PH	
15	Erklärung zum Festhalten an der Confessio Augustana, der Kirchenordnung von 1534, an Luthers Katechismus und dem Frankfurter Rezeß 25. Juli 1563	1563	7/2.2, p. 541	2224	Confession / doctrine	PH	
16	Berufung von Markus Mening zum bremischen Superintendenten 7. September 1570	1570	7/2.2, p. 543	2225	Consistory / synod / government	PH	

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
17	Einigung des geistlichen Ministeriums über die in Bremen gültige Lehre 1572	1572	7/2.2, p. 546	2226	Consistory / synod / government	PH	
18	Austrag des Konfliktes zwischen den Predigern und Jodokus Glaneus vor dem Rat 1. Januar 1575	1575	7/2.2, p. 564	2227	Other	PH	
19a	Bestallung des Predigers Joseph Naso 1582	1582	7/2.2, p. 566	2227	Appointment / oath	R	
19b	Bestallung des Predigers Johannes Varrelmann 1588	1588	7/2.2, p. 568	2227	Appointment / oath	R	
20	Katechismus [1582/83]	1582	7/2.2, p. 570	2228	Catechism / instruction	R	
21	Leges conventuum ministerii 1585	1585	7/2.2, p. 579	2229	Articles / statutes	R	
22	Ansetzung eines Kolloquiums für die Prediger des Landgebietes 16. September 1586	1586	7/2.2, p. 582	2230	Other	R	
23	Hochzeitsordnungen [um 1588]	1588	7/2.2, p. 583	2231	Marriage	R	
24	Mandat gegen Hurerei, Ehebruch und Unzucht auf dem Land 20. Juni 1589	1589	7/2.2, p. 585	2232	Mandate / decree	R	
25a	Beschwerdeschrift des geistlichen Ministeriums 20. Januar 1601	1601	7/2.2, p. 586	2232	Consistory / synod / government	R	
25b	Stellungnahme des Rates zu den Gravamina des Ministeriums 24. März 1601	1601	7/2.2, p. 600	2232	Consistory / synod / government	R	
26	Einladung der Geistlichen des Landgebietes zu einem Kolloquium in Bremen 25. April 1601	1601	7/2.2, p. 608	2233	Other	R	
27	Ordnung für die Feier der Hochzeiten und Kindertaufen 1606	1606	7/2.2, p. 609	2234	Agenda / liturgy	R	
28	Anlage eines Verzeichnisses der Kirchengüter, die zu den Pfarreien des Landgebietes gehören 1609	1609	7/2.2, p. 616	2235	Property / endowment	R	
29	Mandat zu Trauungen, Bettagen und Friedhöfen 8. Dezember 1616	1616	7/2.2, p. 617	2236	Mandate / decree	R	

1.16 Volume 8: Hesse I

37 texts.

1.16.1 Landgraviate of Hesse under Philip (to 1567)

- **Tradition**: Moderate Reformed.
- **Note**: Philip's church stood within the Wittenberg Concord but bore Bucer's stamp (Ziegenhain and Kassel, 1539), and the Kirchenordnung of 1566 belongs to the Strasbourg sphere; here counted as Moderate Reformed.

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
1	a) Unser Landgrave Philipsen Reformation und ordenung von allerley gebrechlicheyt und unordenung 1526	1526	8, p. 37	2245	Other	MR	
1	Reformatio Ecclesiarum Hassiae 1526	1526	8, p. 43	2247	Church order	MR	
2	Stipendiatenordnung 1529	1529	8, p. 66	2250	School / university	MR	
3	Wye sich die kastenmeinster halten sollen in irem ampt 1530	1530	8, p. 68	2251	Poor relief	MR	
4	Ordenung, welcher massen hinfuro die pfarrer und ire helfer, diakon und alle kirchen diener verordenet, gehanthabet, ... abgesatzt werden sall 1531	1531	8, p. 71	2251	Consistory / synod / government	MR	
5	Ordenung der Christlichen kirchen in furstenthumb zu Hessen 1532	1532	8, p. 75	2252	Church order	MR	
6	Ordtnung der Gottes- und Almosen-Casten 1533	1533	8, p. 80	2252	Poor relief	MR	
7	Unser Philipsen von Gottes gnaden Lantgraven Zu Hessen ... Reformation und gemeine lands ordnung ... Auch ordenung und maß wie man mit den ...	1537	8, p. 82	2252	Agenda / liturgy	MR	
8	Ordenung wilcher masse hinfur die Visitatores, Pfarher, und yre helffer, Diacon und alle Kirchenndiener verordnet gehandthabt, und ... abgesatzt ...	1537	8, p. 92	2252	Visitation	MR	
9	Ordenung der Christlichen Kirchenn zucht, Für die Kirchen im Fürstenthumb Hessen 1539	1539	8, p. 101	2252	Church order	MR	
10	Ordenung der Kirchenn übung, Für die Kirchen zu Cassel 1539	1539	8, p. 113	2253	Agenda / liturgy	MR	
10	a) Der kurtze Catechismus... Für die Schüler und andere kinder zu Cassel 1539	1539	8, p. 131	2253	Catechism / instruction	MR	
11	Von Gots gnaden unser Philipsen Landgraven zu Hessen... Ordnung und bevelch, Wie es hinfürter mit den Stipendijs und Stipendiaten... gehalten werden ...	1539	8, p. 143	2253	School / university	MR	
12	Ordenung durch den durchleuchtigen, Hochgebornen Fürsten und herrn, herrn Philipsen, Landtgraven zu Hessen, ... Wie es mit den Stipendiaten... ...	1542	8, p. 145	2254	School / university	MR	
13	Ordenung von Gots gnaden, Unser Philipsen Landtgraven zu Hessen, ... Jn etlichen Notwendigen, zu erhaltung Christlicher Zucht .. .dienlichen Puncten ...	1543	8, p. 148	2254	Discipline / police	MR	
14	Stipendiatenordnung 1546	1546	8, p. 155	2255	School / university	MR	

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
15	Ordenung Christlicher Lehre und Zuchtt 1557	1557	8, p. 161	2256	Discipline / police	MR	
16	Ordenung Unser Philipsen von Gots gnaden Landtgraven zu Hessen ... Wie wir wöllen, Das es hinfürter in unserer Universitet zu Marpurg mit den ...	1560	8, p. 166	2256	School / university	MR	
17	Ordenung wie mans mit den pfar und castengüter allenthalben halten soll 1564	1564	8, p. 176	2257	Local order	MR	
18	Kirchen Ordnung: Wie sich die Pfarherrn und Seelsorger in jrem beruff ... halten sollen 1566	1566	8, p. 178	2257	Other	MR	
19	Fürstliche ordnunge von ... der kyrchenn dieners und Gotts kastenn. o.J	n.d.	8, p. 338	2257	Poor relief	MR	

1.16.2 The Hessian landgraviates: joint synods and orders (1567-1582)

- **Tradition**: Philippist.
- **Note**: The joint synods held to the Wittenberg *Corpus doctrinae* (body of doctrine) of 1560 and refused the Formula of Concord; the Agenda of 1574 keeps the Hessian order of 1566.

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
20	Abschied der ersten Generalsynode zu Marburg 1568	1568	8, p. 347	2262	Consistory / synod / government	PH	
21	Abschied der zweiten Generalsynode zu Kassel 1569	1569	8, p. 351	2263	Consistory / synod / government	PH	
22	Abschied der dritten Generalsynode zu Marburg 1571	1571	8, p. 354	2263	Consistory / synod / government	PH	
23	Abschied der vierten Generalsynode zu Kassel 1572	1572	8, p. 364	2263	Consistory / synod / government	PH	
24	Abschied der fünften Generalsynode zu Marburg 1573	1573	8, p. 367	2263	Consistory / synod / government	PH	
25	Abschied der sechsten Generalsynode zu Kassel 1574	1574	8, p. 371	2265	Consistory / synod / government	PH	
26	Abschied der siebten Generalsynode zu Marburg 1575	1575	8, p. 373	2266	Consistory / synod / government	PH	
27	Die achte Generalsynode zu Kassel 1576	1576	8, p. 377	2267	Consistory / synod / government	PH	

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
28	Abschied des Konvents zu Treysa 1577	1577	8, p. 377	2267	Consistory / synod / government	PH	
29	Abschied der neunten Generalsynode zu Marburg 1578	1578	8, p. 379	2268	Consistory / synod / government	PH	
30	Abschied der zehnten Generalsynode zu Kassel 1579	1579	8, p. 383	2269	Consistory / synod / government	PH	
31	Abschied der elften Generalsynode zu Marburg 1580	1580	8, p. 386	2270	Consistory / synod / government	PH	
32	Abschied der zwölften Generalsynode zu Kassel 1581	1581	8, p. 389	2271	Consistory / synod / government	PH	
33	Abschied der dreizehnten Generalsynode zu Marburg 1582	1582	8, p. 392	2272	Consistory / synod / government	PH	
34	Ordnung und Reformation Unser von Gotts gnaden Wilhelms, Ludwigs, Philipsen und Georgens, Gebrüder Landtgraven zu Hessen 1572	1572	8, p. 394	2272	Local order	PH	
35	Agenda Das ist: Kirchenordnung wie es im Fürstenthumb Hessen mit verkündigung Göttliches worts, reichung der heiligen Sacramenten und andern …	1574	8, p. 408	2272	Church order	PH	

1.17 Volume 9: Hesse II: divided Hesse, Waldeck, Solms, Erbach, Frankfurt, Wetterau cities

101 texts.

1.17.1 Divided Hesse (1582-1618)

- **Tradition**: Philippist; Reformed in Hessen-Kassel from 1600; Lutheran in Hessen-Darmstadt.
- **Note**: Hessen-Marburg (to 1604) and Hessen-Darmstadt stayed Lutheran; Hessen-Kassel under Moritz turned Reformed (Katzenelnbogen 1600, 'Verbesserungspunkte' 1605).
- **Texts by tradition**: Reformed 11, Philippist 5, Lutheran 3.

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
1	Reversformular für die Theologen der Universität Marburg [1583]	1583	9, p. 49	2287	School / university	PH	
2	Artikel und Revers der Theologen an der Universität Marburg 1592	1592	9, p. 51	2287	Articles / statutes	PH	
3a	Diensteid der Pfarrer in der Niedergrafschaft Katzenelnbogen 1597	1597	9, p. 53	2287	Appointment / oath	PH	

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
3b	Diensteid der Pfarrer in der Niedergrafschaft Katzenelnbogen 1598	1598	9, p. 54	2287	Appointment / oath	PH	
4a	Konfessionswechsel in der Niedergrafschaft Katzenelnbogen 1600: Visitationsbericht des Superintendenten Christian Zindel	1600	9, p. 57	2287	Visitation	R	
4b	Konfessionswechsel in der Niedergrafschaft Katzenelnbogen 1600: Resolution Landgraf Moritz' zum Visitationsbericht	1600	9, p. 66	2287	Visitation	R	
5	Mandat zur Einführung der Verbesserungspunkte 1605	1605	9, p. 69	2287	Mandate / decree	R	
6	Mandat für die Superintendenten zur Provinzialsynode 1607	1607	9, p. 71	2287	Mandate / decree	R	
7a	Die Kasseler Generalsynode 1607: Abschied	1607	9, p. 73	2287	Treaty / agreement	R	
7b	Die Kasseler Generalsynode 1607: Bekenntnis	1607	9, p. 86	2287	Confession / doctrine	R	
7c	Die Kasseler Generalsynode 1607: Katechismus	1607	9, p. 91	2287	Catechism / instruction	R	
8	Konsistoriumsordnung 1610	1610	9, p. 99	2287	Consistory / synod / government	R	
9	Eheordnung 1608	1608	9, p. 122	2287	Marriage	R	
10	Visitationsinstruktion für das Konsistorium [1610]	1610	9, p. 133	2287	Visitation	R	
11	Schulordnung 1618	1618	9, p. 136	2287	School / university	R	
12	Polizeiordnung [1574]	1574	9, p. 139	2287	Discipline / police	PH	
13	Predigerwitwenmandat 1604	1604	9, p. 149	2287	Poor relief	L	Hessen-Darmstadt
14a	Regierungsordnung 1617: Mandat zur Beibehaltung der Confessio Augustana	1617	9, p. 150	2287	Mandate / decree	L	Hessen-Darmstadt
14b	Regierungsordnung 1617: Definitoriumsordnung zur Besetzung kirchlicher Stellen	1617	9, p. 154	2287	Consistory / synod / government	L	Hessen-Darmstadt

1.17.2 County of Waldeck

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
1	Landordnung 1525	1525	9, p. 177	2300	Discipline / police	L	
2	Kirchenordnung [1525]	1525	9, p. 180	2300	Church order	L	
3	Reformationsmandat für die Johanniterkommende Niederwildungen 1527	1527	9, p. 184	2300	Mandate / decree	L	
4	Beschlüsse für die Synode von Mengeringhausen 1528	1528	9, p. 185	2300	Consistory / synod / government	L	
5	Die Agende von Johann Hefentreger 1524-1539 5a/g. Glaubensbekenntnis und Bekenntnisordnung für die Stadt Waldeck 1529/1534	1534	9, p. 187	2300	Confession / doctrine	L	
5h	Die Agende von Johann Hefentreger 1524-1539 5a/g. Glaubensbekenntnis und Bekenntnisordnung für die Stadt Waldeck 1529/1534: Niederwildunger …	1533	9, p. 191	2300	Catechism / instruction	L	
6	Kastenordnung für Niederwildungen [1532]	1532	9, p. 193	2300	Poor relief	L	
7	Mandat zur Amts- und Lebensführung der Geistlichen 1539	1539	9, p. 199	2300	Mandate / decree	L	
8	Die „Wildunger Artikel“ der Superintendenten 1539	1539	9, p. 200	2300	Consistory / synod / government	L	
9	Synodalbestimmung 1541	1541	9, p. 202	2300	Consistory / synod / government	L	
10a	Kastenordnung für die Stadt Rhoden: Kastenverwaltungsordnung 1542	1542	9, p. 203	2300	Poor relief	L	
10b	Kastenordnung für die Stadt Rhoden: Ausführungsbestimmungen zur Kastenverwaltungsordnung 1543	1543	9, p. 206	2300	Poor relief	L	
11	Kastenordnung für Korbach 1543	1543	9, p. 208	2300	Poor relief	L	
12	Predigerordnung für Korbach 1545	1545	9, p. 216	2300	Consistory / synod / government	L	
13	Reformationsordnung für das Kloster Flechtdorf 1543	1543	9, p. 220	2300	Monastery / chapter	L	
14a	Mandat gegen Trunksucht und Fastnachtsbräuche in Korbach 1547	1547	9, p. 222	2300	Mandate / decree	L	
14b	Kirchen- und Sittenzuchtordnungen: Mandat zum Gebet für Erhalt des evangelischen Glaubens 1553	1553	9, p. 223	2300	Mandate / decree	L	

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
14c	Kirchen- und Sittenzuchtordnungen: Kirchen- und Zuchtordnung 1555	1555	9, p. 225	2300	Discipline / police	L	
15	Kirchenordnung 1556	1556	9, p. 229	2300	Church order	L	
16	Mandat zur Einsetzung von Visitatoren 1558	1558	9, p. 296	2301	Mandate / decree	L	
17	Mandat gegen Fastnachtsbräuche 1563	1563	9, p. 297	2301	Mandate / decree	L	
18	Visitationsmandat 1569	1569	9, p. 298	2301	Visitation	L	
19	Mandat zur Abschaffung der Kirchweihfeste 1583	1583	9, p. 299	2301	Mandate / decree	L	
20	Mandat zur Abschaffung von Taufexorzismus und Taufkleid 1584	1584	9, p. 300	2301	Mandate / decree	L	
21	Mandat zur Abschaffung der Fastnachtsfeiern 1589/1590	1590	9, p. 301	2301	Mandate / decree	L	
22	Visitationsmandat 1589	1589	9, p. 303	2302	Visitation	L	
23	Feiertagsordnung 1590	1590	9, p. 305	2303	Discipline / police	L	

1.17.3 County of Solms

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.
- **Note**: Solms-Braunfels (with the Hungen classis) turned Reformed from 1582; Solms-Laubach stayed Lutheran.
- **Texts by tradition**: Reformed 7, Lutheran 3.

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
1	Kirchenzuchtordnung 1582	1582	9, p. 321	2311	Discipline / police	R	
2	Strafordnung zur Kirchenzuchtordnung 1584	1584	9, p. 326	2311	Discipline / police	R	
3	Artikel der Hungener Klasse zu den Klassikalkonventen 1583	1583	9, p. 329	2311	Articles / statutes	R	
4	Auszug aus dem Abschied des Konsistorialkonvents 1588	1588	9, p. 332	2311	Consistory / synod / government	R	
5	Kirchenzuchtordnung 1594	1594	9, p. 333	2311	Discipline / police	R	
6	Kirchenzuchtordnung 1599	1599	9, p. 339	2311	Discipline / police	R	
7	Hochzeits- und Taufordnung für Solms-Hungen 1616	1616	9, p. 344	2311	Agenda / liturgy	R	

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
8	Kirchen- und Polizeiordnung für Münzenberg [1575-1580]	1580	9, p. 346	2311	Discipline / police	L	
9	Kirchenordnung für Solms-Laubach [1576-1580]	1580	9, p. 355	2311	Church order	L	
10	Kirchenzuchtordnung für Solms-Laubach 1603	1603	9, p. 398	2311	Discipline / police	L	

1.17.4 County of Erbach

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
1	Kirchenordnung von Michelstadt 1544	1544	9, p. 419	2316	Church order	L	
2	Erbacher Kirchenordnung 1560	1560	9, p. 421	2316	Church order	L	
3	Eheordnung 1572	1572	9, p. 450	2316	Marriage	L	
4	Superintendentenrevers 1575	1575	9, p. 455	2316	Consistory / synod / government	L	
5	Instruktion in Kirchensachen 1577	1577	9, p. 457	2316	Mandate / decree	L	
6	Ordnung der Wiederverheiratung 1587	1587	9, p. 459	2316	Local order	L	

1.17.5 County of Stolberg-Königstein

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
1	Kirchenordnung für die Pfarrei Königstein 1540	1540	9, p. 467	2320	Church order	L	

1.17.6 Imperial city of Frankfurt

- **Tradition**: Moderate Reformed; Lutheran from 1535.
- **Note**: Upper German in the early 1530s, then Lutheran (Wittenberg Concord 1536); the refugee churches are listed under their own confessions.
- **Texts by tradition**: Lutheran 19, Moderate Reformed 4, Reformed 2, Anglican 1.

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
1	Predigt- und Abendmahlsordnung 1530	1530	9, p. 495	2331	Agenda / liturgy	MR	

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
2a	Suspendierung der Messe 1533: Ratsbefehl	1533	9, p. 501	2331	Mandate / decree	MR	
2b	Suspendierung der Messe 1533: Protestationsinstrument	1533	9, p. 502	2331	Other	MR	
3	Predigt- und Kirchenordnung [1533]	1533	9, p. 505	2332	Church order	MR	
4a	Mandate gegen abweichende theologische Lehren: Täufermandat 1535	1535	9, p. 507	2332	Discipline / police	L	
4b	Mandat gegen Prediger zwinglischer und calvinischer Lehren [1537]	1537	9, p. 508	2332	Mandate / decree	L	
5	Resolution auf die Gravamina der Prediger 1542	1542	9, p. 509	2332	Mandate / decree	L	
6	Ordnung der Gottesdienstverteilung [1543]	1543	9, p. 512	2332	Agenda / liturgy	L	
7a	Übereinkunft der Prediger zu Taufe, Eheeinsegnung und Pfarrkonventen	1543	9, p. 514	2332	Agenda / liturgy	L	
7b	Agenden zu Taufe, Abendmahl und Krankenbesuch [1543]: Agende für Taufe und Krankenabendmahl	1543	9, p. 516	2332	Agenda / liturgy	L	
7c	Agenden zu Taufe, Abendmahl und Krankenbesuch [1543]: Abendmahlsagende	1543	9, p. 520	2332	Agenda / liturgy	L	
8	Gottesdienstordnung 1546	1546	9, p. 522	2332	Agenda / liturgy	L	
9	Verzeichnis der Fest- und Feiertage 1553	1553	9, p. 523	2332	Discipline / police	L	
10	Agende 1553	1553	9, p. 524	2332	Agenda / liturgy	L	
11	Organisation der Almosensammlung 1583	1583	9, p. 535	2332	Poor relief	L	
12a	Ordnung der Pfarrkonvente: Beschluss der Konventssitzung 1586	1586	9, p. 536	2332	Consistory / synod / government	L	
12b	Ordnung der Pfarrkonvente: Konventsordnung 1618	1618	9, p. 537	2332	Consistory / synod / government	L	
13	Agende 1589	1589	9, p. 539	2332	Agenda / liturgy	L	
14	Liturgia sacra - Kirchenordnung der französisch-reformierten Gemeinde 1554	1554	9, p. 562	2332	Church order	R	French Reformed congregation (Poullain)

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
15	Diakonieordnung der französisch-reformierten Gemeinde 1585	1585	9, p. 587	2332	Consistory / synod / government	R	French Reformed congregation
16	Old discipline - New discipline/Ordnung der englisch-reformierten Gemeinde 1557	1557	9, p. 588	2332	Other	A	English exile congregation (Marian exiles)
17a	Stiftungsbrief des Armenkastens der Niederländischen Gemeinde A. C. 1585: Stiftungsbrief - französisches Original	1585	9, p. 601	2332	Other	L	Dutch congregation of the Augsburg Confession
17b	Stiftungsbrief des Armenkastens der Niederländischen Gemeinde A. C. 1585: Stiftungsbrief - deutsche Abschrift	1585	9, p. 603	2332	Other	L	Dutch congregation of the Augsburg Confession
18a	Punkte und Artikel der Niederländischen Gemeinde A. C. 1585/1597: Punkte und Artikel - niederländisches Original	1597	9, p. 605	2332	Other	L	Dutch congregation of the Augsburg Confession
18b	Punkte und Artikel der Niederländischen Gemeinde A. C. 1585/1597: Punkte und Artikel - französisches Original	1597	9, p. 609	2332	Other	L	Dutch congregation of the Augsburg Confession
18c	Punkte und Artikel der Niederländischen Gemeinde A. C. 1585/1597: Punkte und Artikel - deutsche Abschrift	1597	9, p. 612	2332	Other	L	Dutch congregation of the Augsburg Confession

1.17.7 Imperial castle and city of Friedberg

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
1	Wiedererrichtung des Friedberger Landkapitels als evangelische Institution 1565	1565	9, p. 627	2338	Agenda / liturgy	L	
2	Stadt-Friedberger Taufordnung [1619]	1619	9, p. 631	2338	Agenda / liturgy	L	
3	Burg-Friedberger Trauformular [vor 1576]	1576	9, p. 633	2338	Other	L	
4	Burg-Friedberger Judentaufformular [um 1600]	1600	9, p. 635	2338	Agenda / liturgy	L	

1.17.8 Imperial city of Gelnhausen

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
1	Eheordnung 1566	1566	9, p. 645	2341	Marriage	L	
2	Kirchenordnung [1568]	1568	9, p. 652	2341	Church order	L	
3	Stadt-, Polizei- und Kirchenzuchtordnung [1599]	1599	9, p. 655	2341	Discipline / police	L	

1.17.9 Imperial city of Wetzlar

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.
- **Texts by tradition**: Lutheran 3, Reformed 2.

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
1	Vergleich zwischen Stift und Stadt zur gemeinsamen Nutzung der Stiftskirche 1561	1561	9, p. 673	2346	Monastery / chapter	L	
2	Verbot, geistliche Gerichte anzurufen 1571	1571	9, p. 676	2346	Mandate / decree	L	
3	Vertrag zur Pfarrer- und Schulmeisterbesoldung 1572	1572	9, p. 677	2346	School / university	L	
4	Dekret zur Aufnahme der französisch-reformierten Flüchtlingsgemeinde 1586	1586	9, p. 678	2346	Mandate / decree	R	for the French Reformed refugee congregation
5	Dekret für die französisch-reformirte Flüchtlingsgemeinde 1596	1596	9, p. 679	2347	Mandate / decree	R	for the French Reformed refugee congregation

1.18 Volume 10: Hesse III: Nassau, Hanau-Münzenberg, Ysenburg

99 texts.

1.18.1 Nassau-Dillenburg

- **Tradition**: Lutheran; Philippist from 1573; Reformed from 1578.
- **Note**: Lutheran under Wilhelm I and early Johann VI; from 1573 a 'Second Reformation', Reformed by 1578/1581.
- **Texts by tradition**: Lutheran 14, Reformed 14, Philippist 1.

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
1	Kirchenordnung [um 1532]	1532	10, p. 57	168	Church order	L	
2	Kirchenordnung [1537]	1537	10, p. 64	169	Church order	L	
3	Kirchenordnung für Hadamar 1546	1546	10, p. 88	170	Church order	L	
4	Visitationsordnung 1550	1550	10, p. 90	171	Visitation	L	
5	Synodalabschied 1552	1552	10, p. 93	172	Consistory / synod / government	L	

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
6	Visitationsordnung 1553	1553	10, p. 96	173	Visitation	L	
7	Ehemandat 1561/1563	1563	10, p. 98	174	Marriage	L	
8	Kirchgangsmandat 1563	1563	10, p. 100	175	Discipline / police	L	
9	Kirchenzuchtmandat 1563	1563	10, p. 101	176	Discipline / police	L	
10	Revers der Kirchendiener in Nassau-Diez [1564]	1564	10, p. 103	177	Consistory / synod / government	L	
11	Kirchgangsmandat 1567	1567	10, p. 104	178	Discipline / police	L	
12	Anordnung einer Generalvisitation 1570	1570	10, p. 105	179	Visitation	L	
13	Visitationsabschied und Kirchenordnung 1570	1570	10, p. 108	180	Church order	L	
14	Ordnung für das Kloster Keppel 1570	1570	10, p. 130	181	Monastery / chapter	L	
15	Agende [1575]	1575	10, p. 146	182	Agenda / liturgy	PH	
16	Reformationsmandat für Stadt und Amt Siegen 1581	1581	10, p. 158	183	Mandate / decree	R	
17	Kirchenordnung 1582	1582	10, p. 160	184	Church order	R	
18	Ordnung für die Spezialkonsistorien [1582]	1582	10, p. 165	185	Consistory / synod / government	R	
19	Abschied der Dillenburger Generalsynode 1582	1582	10, p. 167	186	Consistory / synod / government	R	
20	Zaubereimandat 1582	1582	10, p. 175	187	Discipline / police	R	
21	Mandat gegen leichtfertige Tänze und andere Bräuche 1585	1585	10, p. 176	188	Mandate / decree	R	
22	Visitationspunkte für Nassau-Diez 1585	1585	10, p. 177	189	Visitation	R	
23	Abschied der Herborner Generalsynode 1586	1586	10, p. 179	190	Consistory / synod / government	R	
24	Almosenordnung 1589	1589	10, p. 182	191	Poor relief	R	
25	Verordnung in Kirchensachen 1597	1597	10, p. 190	192	Mandate / decree	R	
26	Bettagsmandat 1607	1607	10, p. 191	193	Agenda / liturgy	R	

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
27	Punkte für die Geistlichen im Amt Siegen 1611	1611	10, p. 194	194	Other	R	
28	Visitationsabschied 1611	1611	10, p. 197	195	Visitation	R	
29	Kirchgangsmandat 1618	1618	10, p. 202	196	Discipline / police	R	

1.18.2 Nassau-Weilburg and Nassau-Saarbrücken

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
30	Ordnung des Almosenkastens 1533/1554	1554	10, p. 204	197	Poor relief	L	
31	Feiertags- und Kirchenordnung 1554	1554	10, p. 206	197	Church order	L	
32	Kirchenordnung 1574/1576	1576	10, p. 208	197	Church order	L	
33	Kirchenzuchtordnung für das Amt Wehen [nach 1602]	1602	10, p. 320	198	Discipline / police	L	
34	Erläuterungspunkte zur Kirchenordnung 1609	1609	10, p. 324	198	Church order	L	
35	Mandat zu Dispensen für Verwandtschaftsehen 1613	1613	10, p. 346	198	Mandate / decree	L	
36	Erläuterungspunkte zur Kirchenordnung 1617	1617	10, p. 347	198	Church order	L	

1.18.3 Nassau-Wiesbaden and Nassau-Idstein

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
37	Extrakt des Eheedikts von 1582	1582	10, p. 358	200	Marriage	L	
38	Ehemandat 1588	1588	10, p. 361	200	Marriage	L	
39	Predigermandat 1589	1589	10, p. 364	200	Mandate / decree	L	
40	Extrakt des Ehebruchedikts 1590	1590	10, p. 368	200	Marriage	L	

1.18.4 County of Hanau-Münzenberg

- **Tradition**: Lutheran; Reformed from 1595.
- **Note**: Lutheran until 1595, then Reformed (orders of 1609).
- **Texts by tradition**: Reformed 24, Lutheran 5.

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
1	Reformordnung für das Kloster Schlüchtern 1543	1543	10, p. 393	203	Monastery / chapter	L	
2a	Visitation 1577: Visitationsausschreiben	1577	10, p. 396	203	Visitation	L	
2b	Kirchenordnung [1537]: Visitation 1577: Visitationsinstruktion	1577	10, p. 398	203	Visitation	L	
3	Eheordnung 1578	1578	10, p. 400	204	Marriage	L	
4	Kirchenratsordnung [1580-1583]	1583	10, p. 407	205	Consistory / synod / government	L	
5	Reformationsmandat für das Amt Rodheim 1596	1596	10, p. 410	206	Mandate / decree	R	
6a	Visitation 1597: Mandat zu Visitation und Sittenzucht	1597	10, p. 411	206	Mandate / decree	R	
6b	Visitationsordnung 1553: Visitation 1597: Visitationsinstruktion	1597	10, p. 415	206	Visitation	R	
7	Kirchenzuchtordnung 1599/1602	1602	10, p. 416	207	Discipline / police	R	
8	Kirchenzuchtordnung für die Stadt Hanau [nach 1599]	1599	10, p. 425	208	Discipline / police	R	
9a	Visitation 1599/1600: Visitationsinstruktion [1599]	1599	10, p. 427	208	Visitation	R	
9b	Visitation 1599/1600: Entwurf von Visitationsfragen 1599	1599	10, p. 432	208	Visitation	R	
9c	Visitation 1599/1600: Visitationsfragen [um 1600]	1600	10, p. 436	208	Visitation	R	
10	Ordnung der Landesverwaltung 1600	1600	10, p. 439	209	Local order	R	
11	Almosenordnung [1600]	1600	10, p. 443	210	Poor relief	R	
12a	Katechisation 1609: Auslegung der 23 Fragstücke zum Heidelberger Katechismus	1609	10, p. 458	211	Catechism / instruction	R	
12b	Katechisation 1609: Anordnung der Katechisation in Stadt und Amt Windecken	1609	10, p. 468	211	Catechism / instruction	R	
12c	Katechisation 1609: Vortrag zur Katechisation in der Stadt Windecken	1609	10, p. 475	211	Catechism / instruction	R	
12d	Katechisation 1609: Mandat zur Katechisation in der Stadt Windecken	1609	10, p. 477	211	Mandate / decree	R	
12e	Katechisation 1609: Anordnung der Katechisation in Hanau	1609	10, p. 480	211	Catechism / instruction	R	

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
12f	Katechisation 1609: Ordnung der Katechisation	1609	10, p. 486	211	Catechism / instruction	R	
12g	Katechisation 1609: Instruktion zur Katechisationsordnung	1609	10, p. 494	211	Catechism / instruction	R	
12h	Katechisation 1609: Instruktion zur Katechisation	1609	10, p. 496	211	Catechism / instruction	R	
12i	Katechisation 1609: Konfirmationsordnung	1609	10, p. 498	211	Agenda / liturgy	R	
13	Presbyteriumsordnung [1609]	1609	10, p. 504	211	Consistory / synod / government	R	
14	Konventsordnung [1609]	1609	10, p. 515	211	Consistory / synod / government	R	
15	Predigtmandat 1609	1609	10, p. 529	211	Mandate / decree	R	
16	Konsistoriumsordnung 1612	1612	10, p. 531	211	Consistory / synod / government	R	
17	Anstellungsrevers für die Geistlichen 1614	1614	10, p. 541	211	Appointment / oath	R	

1.18.5 County of Ysenburg

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.
- **Note**: Ronneburg-Kelsterbach Reformed 1584-1597; Birstein Reformed from 1596; Ronneburg-Ronneburg Reformed from 1601.
- **Texts by tradition**: Lutheran 18, Reformed 12.

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
1	Kirchenordnung 1544	1544	10, p. 569	216	Church order	L	
2	Kirchenordnung für die Stadt Büdingen 1553	1553	10, p. 572	217	Church order	L	
3	Agende [1582]	1582	10, p. 574	218	Agenda / liturgy	L	
4	Erneuerung der Kirchenordnung 1587	1587	10, p. 585	219	Church order	L	
5	Kirchenbußagende [1587]	1587	10, p. 588	220	Agenda / liturgy	L	
6	Fastnachtsmandat 1590	1590	10, p. 593	221	Discipline / police	R	
7	Kirchenzuchtordnung 1591	1591	10, p. 594	222	Discipline / police	R	

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
8	Memorial zur Kirchenzuchtordnung 1592	1592	10, p. 600	223	Discipline / police	R	
9	Abendmahlsmandat 1549	1549	10, p. 604	224	Agenda / liturgy	L	
10	Kirchenzuchtordnung 1557	1557	10, p. 605	225	Discipline / police	L	
11	Mandat gegen Inzest, Vergewaltigung und Ehebruch 1582	1582	10, p. 613	226	Mandate / decree	L	
12	Sittenzuchtordnung 1584	1584	10, p. 615	226	Discipline / police	L	
13	Auftrag zur Formulierung einer Kirchenordnung 1586	1586	10, p. 617	227	Church order	L	
14	Kirchenordnung 1588	1588	10, p. 618	228	Church order	L	
15	Kirchenzuchtordnung 1588	1588	10, p. 637	229	Discipline / police	L	
16	Mandat zur Kirchenordnung 1588	1588	10, p. 643	230	Church order	L	
17	Kirchenordnung 1598	1598	10, p. 644	231	Church order	R	
18	Kirchenzuchtordnung 1598	1598	10, p. 670	232	Discipline / police	R	
19	Visitationsordnung [1598]	1598	10, p. 679	233	Visitation	R	
20	Konsistoriumsordnung 1608	1608	10, p. 683	234	Consistory / synod / government	R	
21	Almosenordnung für die Stadt Büdingen 1611	1611	10, p. 689	235	Poor relief	R	
22	Fastnachtsmandat 1612	1612	10, p. 693	236	Discipline / police	R	
23	Mandat zur Belehrung der Gemeinden über den Katholizismus 1614	1614	10, p. 694	237	Mandate / decree	R	
24	Mandat zum evangelischen Sonntagsgebet 1614	1614	10, p. 696	238	Mandate / decree	R	
25	Kirchenordnung 1580	1580	10, p. 698	239	Church order	R	
26	Ehemandat [1580]	1580	10, p. 701	239	Marriage	L	
27	Kirchen- und Sittenzuchtordnung [1581]/1587	1587	10, p. 703	239	Discipline / police	L	

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
28	Ordnung gegen Ehebruch und Hurerei 1584	1584	10, p. 710	239	Marriage	L	
29	Edikt gegen Unzucht und Ehebruch 1584	1584	10, p. 714	239	Mandate / decree	L	
30	Mandat zur Einschärfung des Edikts gegen Unzucht und Ehebruch [1584]	1584	10, p. 718	239	Mandate / decree	L	

1.19 Volume 11: Bavaria I: Franconia (Nuremberg, Ansbach-Kulmbach, imperial cities)

64 texts.

1.19.1 Imperial city of Nuremberg (to 1528)

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
1	Eins Rats der Stat Nürmberg ordnung des grossen allmusens Haußarmer leut 1522	1522	11, p. 23	244	Other	L	
2	Ordnug, wie man tauffet, bisher im latein gehalten, verteütscht. 1524	1524	11, p. 33	245	Agenda / liturgy	L	
3	Messe des Priors Volprecht. 1524	1524	11, p. 39	247	Agenda / liturgy	L	
4	Artikel, der sich die beeden pröbst ... verglichen haben ... 1524	1524	11, p. 44	247	Articles / statutes	L	
5	Gottesdienstordnung der Pfarrkirchen 1524	1524	11, p. 46	249	Agenda / liturgy	L	
6	Von der evangelischen meß ... zu Nürnberg im Newen Spital durch Andream Döber ... 1525	1525	11, p. 51	249	Agenda / liturgy	L	
7	Form und ordnung eyner Christlichen Meß zu Nürmberg im Newen Spital 1525	1525	11, p. 56	250	Agenda / liturgy	L	
8	Einlaitunge der Eheleut 1526	1526	11, p. 58	252	Agenda / liturgy	L	

1.19.2 Brandenburg-Ansbach-Kulmbach (to 1528)

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
1	Ein cristenliche Ordenung der Betler halben ...in der Stat Kitzingen ... 1523	1523	11, p. 72	253	Other	L	
2	Dorffmayster ...zu Wendelstains fürhalten jrem new angeendem Pfarrherrn gethan. 1524	1524	11, p. 77	254	Articles / statutes	L	

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
3	Handlung und beschluß, des ... Fürsten Casimir, ... mit sampt seinen gaistlichen Prelaten und hochgelerten, das Gotswort betreffent. ... 1524	1524	11, p. 80	255	Mandate / decree	L	
4	Ansbacher Landtagsabschied 1525	1525	11, p. 82	257	Treaty / agreement	L	
5	Der ... Marggraven zu Brandenburg ... anzeigen, wie ... durch ... prediger vil aufrur fürkummen werden mög. Auch ein kurze ... underricht, wie ...	1525	11, p. 84	257	Other	L	
6	Abschied, ... wes sich ... Herr Casimir ... bis auf ein zukünftig Nacionalversammlung, ... in jrer Gnaden Land ... zu halten vereynigt haben. [1526.]	1526	11, p. 88	258	Treaty / agreement	L	
7	Ordnung der Tauff nach wirtzburgischer Rubricken von wort und wort verteutscht. [1526.]	1526	11, p. 98	260	Agenda / liturgy	L	
8	Abschied des ... Fürsten, ... herrn Geörgen ... mit ... gemeiner Landschafft ... 1528	1528	11, p. 102	260	Treaty / agreement	L	
9	Mandat zur Durchführung der Reformation. 1528	1528	11, p. 105	262	Mandate / decree	L	
10	Mandat über Pfründenbesetzung. 1528	1528	11, p. 106	263	Mandate / decree	L	
11	Der evangelische Priestereid. 1528	1528	11, p. 107	264	Appointment / oath	L	

1.19.3 Brandenburg and Nuremberg together (1528-1533)

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
1	Die Ansbacher 30 Fragen. 1528	1528	11, p. 126	267	Other	L	
2	Die Nürnberger 23 Lehrartikel. 1528	1528	11, p. 128	267	Catechism / instruction	L	
3	Die brandenburgisch-nürnbergischeKirchenordnung von 1528	1528	11, p. 135	269	Church order	L	
4a	Ansbacher Landtagsabschied 1525: Kirchenordnung ... 1533	1533	11, p. 140	269	Church order	L	
4b	Ansbacher Landtagsabschied 1525: Catechismus oder Kinderpredig. 1533	1533	11, p. 206	270	Catechism / instruction	L	
4c	Ansbacher Landtagsabschied 1525: Brandenburgische Nachträge. 1533	1533	11, p. 279	271	Other	L	

1.19.4 Brandenburg-Ansbach-Kulmbach (from 1528/1533)

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.

- **Interim**: 1 text(s) tied to the Augsburg Interim (see the last column).

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
1	Gottesdienstmandat 1531	1531	11, p. 306	275	Agenda / liturgy	L	
2	Ordnung singens und lesens bei den stiften. 1533	1533	11, p. 311	275	Agenda / liturgy	L	
3	Kirchenvisitation im Markgraftum Brandenburg unter dem Gebirg. 1536	1536	11, p. 317	277	Visitation	L	
4	Mehrung der vorigen kirchenordnung. 1548	1548	11, p. 325	277	Church order	L	**Interim order**; the 'Auctuarium', Brandenburg-Ansbach's adaptation of its order to the Interim
5	Wassertrüdinger Kapitelsordnung. 1545	1545	11, p. 332	279	Consistory / synod / government	L	
6	Vereinbarungen der Theologen auf der Synode 1556	1556	11, p. 335	280	Consistory / synod / government	L	
7a	Ordnung der Tauff nach wirtzburgischer Rubricken von wort und wort verteutscht. [1526.]: Synodalordnung von 1556	1556	11, p. 338	281	Consistory / synod / government	L	
7b	Ordnung der Tauff nach wirtzburgischer Rubricken von wort und wort verteutscht. [1526.]: Schreiben an die Amtmänner	1526	11, p. 341	281	Other	L	
8	Visitationsvermahnung im Oberland. 1558	1558	11, p. 344	282	Agenda / liturgy	L	
9	Kapitelsordnung von 1565/1578	1578	11, p. 346	283	Consistory / synod / government	L	
10	Gewalt zur specialvisitation. 1565	1565	11, p. 360	283	Visitation	L	
11	Übertragung der Kapitelsordnung auf das Oberland. 1572	1572	11, p. 362	285	Consistory / synod / government	L	
12	Errichtung eines Ehegerichts in Ansbach. 1556	1556	11, p. 364	286	Consistory / synod / government	L	
13	Gerichtsstand der Geistlichen. 1565	1565	11, p. 365	287	Other	L	
14	Eheartikel vom 10. Juni 1565 bzw. 10. Juni 1573	1573	11, p. 367	288	Marriage	L	

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
15	Ehegerichtsordnung und Errichtung des Konsistoriums zu Kulmbach vom 18. Okt. 1567	1567	11, p. 371	289	Consistory / synod / government	L	
16	Begleitschreiben zur Konkordie von 1570	1570	11, p. 377	290	Other	L	
17	Konsistorialordnung von 1594	1594	11, p. 379	291	Consistory / synod / government	L	
18	Figural und coral zu ziemlicher zeit in der kirchen zu singen und in den schulen anzurichten. 1538	1538	11, p. 397	292	School / university	L	
19	Verzeichnüs, wie es in beden kirchen alhie zue Feuchtwang gehalten würd. 1563	1563	11, p. 399	293	Other	L	
20	Ordo ecclesiasticus in Hof von Enoch Widmann. 1592	1592	11, p. 405	293	Church order	L	

1.19.5 Imperial city of Nuremberg (from 1533)

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
1	Agendbüchlein für die Pfarrherrn auff dem Land. Durch Vitum Dietrich. 1545	1545	11, p. 487	296	Agenda / liturgy	L	
2	Vermanung ..., die ein Pfarrherr ... jerlich ... vorlesen ..., welcher gestalt sich sein pfarrvolck, in empfahung des Heyligen Sacraments, und dann ...	1558	11, p. 554	297	Other	L	
3	Mandat wider die Hurerei. 1582	1582	11, p. 557	299	Mandate / decree	L	

1.19.6 Imperial city of Rothenburg ob der Tauber

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
1	Ordnung der Kirchen in eines Erbarn Raths der Stat Rothenburg uf der Tauber Oberkeit und gebiet gelegen. 1559	1559	11, p. 566	300	Church order	L	
2	Instruction, wie die Kirchenordnung gehandhabt und vollzogen werden soll. 1558	1558	11, p. 599	302	Church order	L	

1.19.7 Imperial city of Schweinfurt with Gochsheim and Sennfeld

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
1	Kirchenordnung Eines Erbarn Raths des heiligen Reichs Stat Schweinfurt. ...1543	1543	11, p. 624	303	Church order	L	
2	Ordnung, wie es an den sontagen und festtagen alhie zu Schweinfurt ... sol gehalten ... werden. 1576	1576	11, p. 645	304	Discipline / police	L	
3	Dorfordnung für Gochsheim und Sennfeld. 1543	1543	11, p. 649	306	Other	L	

1.19.8 Imperial city of Weißenburg (Franconia)

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
1	Ein ... auszug ... der ordnung in dem gottesdienst bei der christlichen gemain zu Weißenburg. 1528	1528	11, p. 657	307	Agenda / liturgy	L	
2	Ungefärlicher begriff des kirchenregiments ordnung und bestellung (um 1590)	1590	11, p. 665	308	Consistory / synod / government	L	

1.19.9 Imperial city of Windsheim

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
	Ordnung, wie es nun hinfüro mit dem gefelle dies gemeinen castens ... gehalten werden soll. 1524	1524	11, p. 674	312	Local order	L	

1.19.10 County of Castell

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
	Dorfsordnung, ... in ... Obereisensheim ... 1579	1579	11, p. 684	314	Other	L	

1.19.11 County of Rieneck

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
1	Ulmers Gottesdienstform. 1544	1544	11, p. 698	317	Agenda / liturgy	L	
2	Vesperordnung zu Lohr. 1588	1588	11, p. 699	318	Agenda / liturgy	L	

1.19.12 County of Wertheim

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
1	Wertheimer Kirchenordnung von 1524	1524	11, p. 707	322	Church order	L	
2	Wertheimer Kirchenordnung um 1555	1555	11, p. 708	323	Church order	L	

1.19.13 Lordship of Thüngen

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
1	Thüngenische Kirchenordnung. 1564	1564	11, p. 731	326	Church order	L	
2	Lectiones sacrae in Burgsinn. 1587	1587	11, p. 743	327	Agenda / liturgy	L	

1.20 Volume 12: Bavaria II: Swabia (Augsburg and the Swabian imperial cities)

46 texts.

1.20.1 Imperial city of Augsburg

- **Tradition**: Moderate Reformed, save Rhegius's baptism rite (no. 3, Lutheran); Lutheran from 1549.
- **Note**: Upper German (Zwinglian-Bucerian) until the Interim; Lutheran after 1552/1555. Rhegius's baptism rite is coded by its author, from 1531 superintendent of the Lutheran church at Celle.
- **Texts by tradition**: Moderate Reformed 13, Lutheran 4.

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
1	Priesterhochzeit 1523	1523	12, p. 33	333	Marriage	MR	
2	Das frugebet, so man anstatt der bäpstischen meß haltet	1529	12, p. 35	333	Agenda / liturgy	MR	dated by the editor: oldest edition 1529
3	Taufritus des Urban Rhegius	n.d.	12, p. 39	333	Agenda / liturgy	L	between 1524 and 1530, when Rhegius was the city's preacher; coded by its author
4	Form und Ordnung des Herrn nachtmal betreffend 1530	1530	12, p. 40	334	Agenda / liturgy	MR	
5	Reformationsmandat vom 29. Juli 1534	1534	12, p. 44	335	Mandate / decree	MR	
6	Bestallung eines Predigers 1535	1535	12, p. 46	336	Appointment / oath	MR	
7	Dekret über die Wochengottesdienste vom 9. Juni 1537	1537	12, p. 49	337	Mandate / decree	MR	
8a	Kirchenordnung von 1537	1537	12, p. 50	338	Church order	MR	
8b	Auszug aus der Kirchenordnung	1537	12, p. 65	338	Church order	MR	dated by the editor: the summary of the church order of 1537, laid before the council with it

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
9	Die zehen gebot, Articul des Glaubens, Und das Vater unser... (1537)	1537	12, p. 67	338	Other	MR	
10	Forma, wie von dem hailigen Tauf, und dem hailigen Sacrament des leibs und bluts Christ,... vom Elichen Stand... zu reden sey... 1537	1537	12, p. 72	338	Agenda / liturgy	MR	
	II. Feiertagsordnung vom 22. Juli 1537	1537	12, p. 84	339	Discipline / police	MR	
12	Forma. Wie vom hailigen Tauf, und dem H. Sacrament des Leibs und Bluts Christi... vom Eelichen Stand... zu reden sei... (1545)	1545	12, p. 85	339	Agenda / liturgy	MR	
13	Gottesdienstformen um 1548	1548	12, p. 93	340	Agenda / liturgy	MR	
14	Forma. Wie vom hailigen tauf, und dem hailigen Sacrament des leibs und Bluts Christi... von dem trost der Kranken... vom Ehlichen Stand... zureden ...	1555	12, p. 95	340	Agenda / liturgy	L	
15	Vergleichartikel von 1591	1591	12, p. 109	341	Treaty / agreement	L	
16	Einzelbestimmungen zu den Berufungsverhandlungen 1591	1591	12, p. 112	342	Appointment / oath	L	

1.20.2 Imperial city of Dinkelsbühl

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
1	Kapitelsordnung 1535	1535	12, p. 126	346	Consistory / synod / government	L	
2	Bestallungsurkunde des Predigers Konrad Abel 1542	1542	12, p. 128	347	Appointment / oath	L	
3	Kirchenpflegeordnung 1574	1574	12, p. 131	348	Consistory / synod / government	L	
4	Generalbestallung auf alle und jede helfer... 1573	1573	12, p. 134	348	Appointment / oath	L	
5	Revers des helfers	n.d.	12, p. 141	348	Appointment / oath	L	
6	Wes man sich in aufnemung und bestellung eines vorsingers verhalten soll	n.d.	12, p. 142	348	Appointment / oath	L	
7	Warhaftige copi der vom rat ubergebnen form, darauf die kirchendiener angelobt haben	n.d.	12, p. 144	348	Consistory / synod / government	L	

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
8	Fragstueck, darauf alle pfarrer... gefragt werden sollen	n.d.	12, p. 145	348	Other	L	
9	Bericht, wie man es halten soll	n.d.	12, p. 146	348	Mandate / decree	L	

1.20.3 Imperial city of Donauwörth

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
	Kirchenordnung von Donauwörth 1545	1545	12, p. 158	351	Church order	L	

1.20.4 Imperial city of Kempten

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
	Primus Trubers Kirchenordnung 1553	1553	12, p. 175	354	Church order	L	

1.20.5 Imperial city of Lindau

- **Tradition**: Moderate Reformed; Lutheran from 1549.
- **Note**: A Tetrapolitan city (Upper German) until the Interim; Lutheran afterwards.
- **Texts by tradition**: Moderate Reformed 3, Lutheran 2.

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
1	Zuchtordnung von 1533	1533	12, p. 186	357	Discipline / police	MR	
2	Bekanntmachungen zur Einschärfung der Zuchtordnung (Lasterstraf) 1539	1539	12, p. 198	358	Discipline / police	MR	
3	Almusenordnung in der statt Lindaw 1533	1533	12, p. 200	359	Poor relief	MR	
4	Agenda,... wie es... in der Pfarrkirchen zu Lindaw... 1573	1573	12, p. 203	360	Agenda / liturgy	L	
5	Agenda, wie es auf dem land... zu Rüte und Eschach... (1573)	1573	12, p. 218	361	Agenda / liturgy	L	

1.20.6 Imperial city of Memmingen

- **Tradition**: Moderate Reformed; Lutheran from 1549.
- **Note**: A Tetrapolitan city (Upper German) until the Interim; Lutheran afterwards.
- **Texts by tradition**: Moderate Reformed 4, Lutheran 1.

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
1	Kirchenordnung von 1528	1528	12, p. 223	363	Church order	MR	
2	Ordnung und Brauch deß Herrennachtmals... (1529)	1529	12, p. 239	364	Agenda / liturgy	MR	
3	Zuchtordnung von 1532	1532	12, p. 247	365	Discipline / police	MR	
4	Kirchenordnung... 1569	1569	12, p. 256	366	Church order	L	
5	Meßpfründenordnung 1542	1542	12, p. 267	367	Agenda / liturgy	MR	

1.20.7 Imperial city of Nördlingen

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
1	Von der Evangelischen Mesß... Durch Caspar Kantz... (1522)	1522	12, p. 285	369	Agenda / liturgy	L	
2	Renovatio Ecclesiae Nordlingiacensis... 1525	1525	12, p. 289	370	Other	L	
3	Der statt Nordling... reformation und kirchenordnung... 1538	1538	12, p. 307	371	Church order	L	
4	Kirchenordnung Kaspar Löners 1544	1544	12, p. 310	372	Church order	L	
5	Ordnung der ceremonien in der pfarkirchen zu Sant Georgen..., gestelt durch M. Caspar Löhner... 1544, und jetzo wider ubersehen ... durch Melchior ...	1555	12, p. 317	373	Agenda / liturgy	L	
6	Nördlinger Superintendenzordnung 1564	1564	12, p. 330	374	Consistory / synod / government	L	
7	Kirchenordnung von 1579	1579	12, p. 335	375	Church order	L	

1.20.8 County of Oettingen-Oettingen

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
	Visitationsordnung 1591	1591	12, p. 403	378	Visitation	L	

1.21 Volume 13: Bavaria III: Altbayern (Pfalz-Neuburg, Upper Palatinate, Regensburg)

82 texts.

1.21.1 Duchy of Pfalz-Neuburg

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
1	Reformationsmandat vom 22.Juni 1542	1542	13, p. 39	385	Mandate / decree	L	
2	Kirchenordnungen von 1543	1543	13, p. 41	386	Church order	L	
2a	Der erste teil der kirchenordnung. Von der lehre insgemein	n.d.	13, p. 44	386	Church order	L	
2b	Der ander teil der kirchenordnung. Von den heiligen sacramenten und andern christlichen ceremonien	n.d.	13, p. 46	386	Church order	L	
2c	Der dritte teil der kirchenordnung. Catechismus	n.d.	13, p. 98	386	Church order	L	
3	Die geänderte Taufordnung. 1543	1543	13, p. 100	387	Agenda / liturgy	L	
4	Bekanntmachung der Bestallung eines Superintendenten vom 16. Nov. 1545	1545	13, p. 103	388	Consistory / synod / government	L	
5	Kirchenordnung. 1554	1554	13, p. 104	389	Church order	L	
6	Verordnung zur Beseitigung der Bilder und Feldkapellen vom 12. Aug. 1555	1555	13, p. 106	390	Mandate / decree	L	
7	Bekanntmachung einer Superintendentenbestallung vom 17. April 1555	1555	13, p. 107	391	Consistory / synod / government	L	
8	Bestallung eines Pfarrers vom 10. März 1555	1555	13, p. 108	392	Appointment / oath	L	
9	Revers eines Pfarrers vom 11. März 1555	1555	13, p. 110	393	Appointment / oath	L	
10	Zuchtordnung gegenüber den Geistlichen vom 16. Febr. 1556	1556	13, p. 111	394	Discipline / police	L	
11	Edikt über Eheordnung, Sonntagsheiligung und gegen verschiedene Laster vom 8. Nov. 1555	1555	13, p. 114	395	Mandate / decree	L	
12	Verordnung gegen die Wiedertäufer vom 9. Mai 1558	1558	13, p. 117	396	Discipline / police	L	
13	Visitationsordnung vom 23. Aug. 1558	1558	13, p. 120	397	Visitation	L	
14	Kirchenordnung vom 2. Jan. 1560	1560	13, p. 125	398	Church order	L	
15	Visitationsinstruktion vom 28. Juni 1560 sowie vom 16. Nov. 1566	1566	13, p. 128	399	Visitation	L	

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
15a	Visitationsinstruktion vom 28. Juni 1560 sowie vom 16. Nov. 1566: Instruktion	1566	13, p. 128	399	Mandate / decree	L	
15b	Visitationsinstruktion vom 28. Juni 1560 sowie vom 16. Nov. 1566: Beilagen	1566	13, p. 138	399	Other	L	
16	Superintendenturordnung vom 6. Dez. 1562	1562	13, p. 142	400	Consistory / synod / government	L	
17	Mandat gegen die Kalvinisten vom 1. Juni 1564	1564	13, p. 147	401	Mandate / decree	L	
18	Kirchenordnung vom 19. Nov. 1570	1570	13, p. 151	402	Church order	L	
19	Visitationsinstruktion vom 9. April 1576	1576	13, p. 163	403	Visitation	L	
20	Generalartikel vom 20. Febr. 1576	1576	13, p. 168	404	Visitation	L	
21	Konsistorialordnung vom 7. Juni 1576	1576	13, p. 236	405	Consistory / synod / government	L	
22	Eheordnung vom 2. Jan. 1577	1577	13, p. 241	406	Marriage	L	
23	Prüfungsordnung vom 13. Mai 1577	1577	13, p. 249	407	Other	L	

1.21.2 Upper Palatinate (Electoral Palatinate)

- **Tradition**: Lutheran; Reformed from 1559; Lutheran from 1577; Reformed from 1583.
- **Note**: Lutheran under Ottheinrich; Friedrich III's Calvinizing (from 1559) was resisted; Ludwig VI restored Lutheranism (1577); Reformed again from 1583.
- **Texts by tradition**: Reformed 13, Lutheran 9.

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
1	Amberg, Spitalgottesdienst. 1544	1544	13, p. 282	410	Agenda / liturgy	L	
2	Bericht des Predigers Dr. Faber vom 29. Nov. 1550 über die Kirchenordnung in Amberg	1550	13, p. 285	411	Church order	L	
3	Kirchenordnung Amberg. 1555/1557	1557	13, p. 288	411	Church order	L	
4	Visitationsordnung vom 15. Febr. 1557	1557	13, p. 295	413	Visitation	L	
5	Amberger Vier Punkte vom 9. Dezember 1566	1566	13, p. 298	414	Other	R	
6	Amberger Mandat vom 20. Jan. 1567	1567	13, p. 303	415	Mandate / decree	R	

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
7	Visitationsordnung vom 10. (16.) Aug. 1579	1579	13, p. 305	416	Visitation	L	
7a	Visitationsordnung vom 10. (16.) Aug. 1579: Offen Patent	1579	13, p. 305	416	Mandate / decree	L	
7b	Visitationsordnung vom 10. (16.) Aug. 1579: Instruktion	1579	13, p. 306	416	Mandate / decree	L	
7c	Visitationsordnung vom 10. (16.) Aug. 1579: Interrogatoria	1579	13, p. 314	416	Other	L	
8	Einführung von Senioren. 1581	1581	13, p. 319	417	Other	L	
9	Einschärfung verschiedener Mandate gegen Laster und kirchliche Mißstände vom Juni 1584	1584	13, p. 320	418	Discipline / police	R	
10	Mandatum de non calumniando vom 24. Nov. 1584	1584	13, p. 325	419	Mandate / decree	R	
11	Kirchenratsinstruktion vom 3. März 1585	1585	13, p. 328	420	Consistory / synod / government	R	
12	Kurfürstliche Erklärung an die Landstände vom 18. März 1592	1592	13, p. 331	421	Mandate / decree	R	
13	Neumarkter Mandat vom 8. April 1592	1592	13, p. 334	422	Mandate / decree	R	
14	Amberger Rezeß vom 8. Juni 1593	1593	13, p. 336	423	Other	R	
15	Institutionswerk vom 6. Juli 1596	1596	13, p. 338	424	Agenda / liturgy	R	
16	Ordnung, darnach sich kirchen- und schuldiener der statt Amberg hinfort richten sollen. Vom 9. Dez. 1597	1597	13, p. 341	425	School / university	R	
17	Befehl über den Gerichtsstand der Geistlichen in der Oberpfalz vom 7. Febr. 1598	1598	13, p. 345	426	Mandate / decree	R	
18	Generalanweisung vom 20. März 1598	1598	13, p. 346	427	Mandate / decree	R	
19	Presbyterii Ordnung vom 7. Aug. 1615	1615	13, p. 352	428	Consistory / synod / government	R	

1.21.3 Imperial city of Regensburg

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.
- **Interim**: 1 text(s) tied to the Augsburg Interim (see the last column).

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
1	Wahrhaftiger Bericht eines Rats der Stadt Regensburg über die Einsetzung des Abendmahls. 10. Okt. 1542	1542	13, p. 389	431	Agenda / liturgy	L	
2	Aufrichtung der wahren Religion. 14. Okt. 1542	1542	13, p. 394	433	Other	L	
3	Vermahnung vor der Beichte	n.d.	13, p. 395	434	Agenda / liturgy	L	
5	Kirchenordnung des Noppus. 1543	1543	13, p. 406	436	Church order	L	
6	Ordnung des Abendmahls und der Vesper. 1543	1543	13, p. 412	436	Agenda / liturgy	L	
7	Vermahnung ... wider etliche Laster vom 16. Aug. 1543	1543	13, p. 414	437	Agenda / liturgy	L	
8	Errichtung eines Konsistoriums vom 23. Juni 1545	1545	13, p. 416	438	Consistory / synod / government	L	
9	Bußvermahnung wegen des Verhaltens während des Interims vom 22. Juni 1552	1552	13, p. 417	439	Agenda / liturgy	L	**After the Interim**
10	Kirchenordnung des Justus Jonas. 1553	1553	13, p. 419	440	Church order	L	
11	Gottesdienstverteilung. 1553	1553	13, p. 428	441	Agenda / liturgy	L	
12	Ordinationsordnung. 1553	1553	13, p. 429	442	Agenda / liturgy	L	
13	Warum die Leviten- und Meßgewand sollen abgetan werden, den Kirchen fürzutragen, vom 29. April 1554	1554	13, p. 432	443	Agenda / liturgy	L	
14	Ordnung der Kirchendiener [1553?]	1553	13, p. 434	445	Church order	L	
15	Ordnung in Sterbsläuften. 21. Sept. 1562	1562	13, p. 435	446	Local order	L	
	Nachtrag vom 31. Juli 1563	1563	13, p. 437	446	Other	L	
16	Kirchenregimentsordnung vom 9. März 1556	1556	13, p. 438	447	Consistory / synod / government	L	
17	Vergleichsartikel mit Gallus vom 14. März 1560	1560	13, p. 446	448	Treaty / agreement	L	
18	Verbot des Disputierens vom 1. Juli 1566	1566	13, p. 450	449	Mandate / decree	L	
19	Kirchenordnung des Gallus (um 1567)	1567	13, p. 452	450	Church order	L	

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
4	Vermahnung vor der Kommunion	n.d.	13, p. 463	450	Agenda / liturgy	L	
20	Kanzelabkündigung über das Verfahren bei Kirchenzucht vom 20. Febr. 1576	1576	13, p. 490	451	Discipline / police	L	
21	Kirchenregimentsordnung vom 2. Aug. 1572 und vom 12. April 1588	1588	13, p. 493	452	Consistory / synod / government	L	
	Nachtrag vom 9. Febr. 1599	1599	13, p. 510	452	Other	L	
22	Konsistorialordnung vom 19. Jan. 1588	1588	13, p. 512	453	Consistory / synod / government	L	

1.21.4 County of Ortenburg

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
1	Reformationsmandat vom 25. Old. 1563	1563	13, p. 529	456	Mandate / decree	L	
2	Gottesdienstordnung. 1563	1563	13, p. 531	457	Agenda / liturgy	L	
3	Bestallung des Pfarrers Pflacher vom 19. Febr. 1573 bzw. 1578	1578	13, p. 533	458	Appointment / oath	L	

1.21.5 Lordship of Rothenberg

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
1	Pfarrereid vom 5. Nov. 1601	1601	13, p. 545	460	Other	L	
2	Kirchenordnung vom 30. Okt. 1618	1618	13, p. 547	460	Church order	L	
3	Ordinationsordnung vom 9. Nov. 1618	1618	13, p. 558	461	Agenda / liturgy	L	

1.21.6 Lordship of Wolfstein

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
1	Kirchenordnung. 1574	1574	13, p. 566	462	Church order	L	
2	Eheordnung (um 1574)	1574	13, p. 593	463	Marriage	L	

1.22 Volume 14: Electoral Palatinate (Kurpfalz)

110 texts.

1.22.1 Electoral Palatinate (Kurpfalz)

- **Tradition**: by reign (see note).
- **Note**: Lutheran under Friedrich II and Ottheinrich; Reformed under Friedrich III (1563 order); Lutheran under Ludwig VI (1576-1583), while his brother Johann Casimir kept the Reformed order in Pfalz-Lautern (nos. 78-79); Reformed again from 1583.
- **Texts by tradition**: Reformed 67, Lutheran 43.

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
25	[Mandat gegen das Unmaß bei Hochzeiten und Banketten vom 12. Dezember 1561]	1561	14, p. 35	468	Marriage	R	described in the introduction only; Friedrich III
28	Pfaltzgrave Friderichs, churfürsten, aufgerichte christliche eheordnung [für die Oberpfalz vom 12. Juli 1563]	1563	14, p. 36	468	Marriage	R	described in the introduction only; Friedrich III
34	Form, wie das heilig nachtmahl unsers herrn und heilands Jesu Christi sampt der vorbereitung in der kirchen zu Heidelberg und anderen kirchen der …	1564	14, p. 49	468	Agenda / liturgy	R	described in the introduction only; Friedrich III
37	Pfaltzgrave Friderichs, churfürstens etc., aufgerichte christliche policeyordnung [von 1565]	1565	14, p. 50	468	Discipline / police	R	described in the introduction only; Friedrich III
38	Pfaltzgrave Friderichs churfürstliche, aufgerichte christliche eheordnung [von 1565]	1565	14, p. 50	468	Marriage	R	described in the introduction only; Friedrich III
39	Kirchenordnung … [von 1565]	1565	14, p. 50	468	Church order	R	described in the introduction only; Friedrich III
42	Kirchenordnung … [von 1567]	1567	14, p. 52	468	Church order	R	described in the introduction only; Friedrich III
43	Kirchenordnung … [von 1569]	1569	14, p. 52	468	Church order	R	described in the introduction only; Friedrich III
53	Pfalntzgrave Friderichs, churfürstens etc., und Marggrave Philipsen zu Baden etc. aufgerichte christliche policeyordnung in der gemeinschaft …	1572	14, p. 56	468	Discipline / police	R	described in the introduction only; Friedrich III
57	Mandat und constitution … [für Oberpfalz vom 11. August 1575]	1575	14, p. 58	468	Mandate / decree	R	described in the introduction only; Friedrich III
59	[Bestallung eines Glöckners vom 20. April 1577]	1577	14, p. 62	468	Appointment / oath	L	described in the introduction only; Ludwig VI
60	Kirchenordnung, wie es mit der christlichen lehre, administrierung der heiligen sacramenten und ceremonien in des durchleuchtigsten, hochgebornen …	1577	14, p. 63	468	Church order	L	described in the introduction only; Ludwig VI

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
61	[Kirchenratsordnung von etwa 1577]	1577	14, p. 65	468	Consistory / synod / government	L	described in the introduction only; Ludwig VI
62	Pfaltzgrave Ludwigs, churfürstens etc., aufgerichte christliche policeyordnung [vom 1. Januar 1578]	1578	14, p. 66	468	Discipline / police	L	described in the introduction only; Ludwig VI
63	Pfalntzgrave Ludwigs, churfürstens etc., und bischof Marquards zu Speir etc. aufgerichte christliche policeyordnung in der gemeynschaft Altenstatt …	1578	14, p. 66	468	Discipline / police	L	described in the introduction only; Ludwig VI
64	Mandat und constitution … [für Oberpfalz vom 19. September 1579]	1579	14, p. 68	468	Mandate / decree	L	described in the introduction only; Ludwig VI
65	Mandat und constitution … [für Rheinpfalz vom 26. September 1579]	1579	14, p. 68	468	Mandate / decree	L	described in the introduction only; Ludwig VI
68	[Christliche Polizeiordnung vom 4. April 1582]	1582	14, p. 69	468	Discipline / police	L	described in the introduction only; Ludwig VI
69	[Christliche Almosenordnung vom 4. April 1582]	1582	14, p. 69	468	Poor relief	L	described in the introduction only; Ludwig VI
70	Pfaltzgraf Ludwigs churfürstens und hertzog Reichards, pfaltzgrafen etc., deßgleichen marggrafe Philipsen zu Baden etc., aufgerichte christliche …	1582	14, p. 70	468	Discipline / police	L	described in the introduction only; Ludwig VI
71	[Christliche Ehe- und Ehegerichtsordnung vom 3. September 1582]	1582	14, p. 70	468	Consistory / synod / government	L	described in the introduction only; Ludwig VI
72	Mandat und constitution … [vom 3. September 1582]	1582	14, p. 70	468	Mandate / decree	L	described in the introduction only; Ludwig VI
73	Mandat und constitution … [von 1583]	1583	14, p. 70	468	Mandate / decree	L	described in the introduction only; Ludwig VI
74	[Christliche Polizeiordnung von 1583]	1583	14, p. 70	468	Discipline / police	L	described in the introduction only; Ludwig VI
75	[Christliche Almosenordnung von 1583]	1583	14, p. 70	468	Poor relief	L	described in the introduction only; Ludwig VI
76	[Christliche Eheordnung von 1583]	1583	14, p. 70	468	Marriage	L	described in the introduction only; Ludwig VI

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
77	Mandat und constitution ... [von 1583]	1583	14, p. 70	468	Mandate / decree	L	described in the introduction only; Ludwig VI
78	Kirchenordnung ... [von 1576/1577]	1577	14, p. 72	468	Church order	R	described in the introduction only; Johann Casimir in Pfalz-Lautern
79	Des durchleuchtigen, hochgebornen fürsten und herrn, herrn Johann Casimirs, pfaltzgrafen bey Rhein, hertzogen in Bayern etc., christliche eheordnung ...	1578	14, p. 73	468	Marriage	R	described in the introduction only; Johann Casimir in Pfalz-Lautern
81	Mandat und constitution ... [vom 17. Mai 1585]	1585	14, p. 77	468	Mandate / decree	R	described in the introduction only; Johann Casimir as administrator
82	Kirchenordnung, wie es mit der christlichen lehre, heiligen sacramenten und ceremonien in der chur- und fürstlichen Pfaltz bey Rhein gehalten wirdt. ...	1585	14, p. 77	468	Church order	R	described in the introduction only; Johann Casimir as administrator
88	[Bestallung eines Glöckners, zwischen 1583 und 1592]	1592	14, p. 81	468	Appointment / oath	R	described in the introduction only; Johann Casimir as administrator
89	Mandat und constitution ... [für Oberpfalz vom 8. Januar 1593]	1593	14, p. 83	468	Mandate / decree	R	described in the introduction only; Friedrich IV
90	[Revers und Bestallung eines Kirchenrats vom 1. Mai 1593]	1593	14, p. 83	468	Consistory / synod / government	R	described in the introduction only; Friedrich IV
92	[Christliche Polizeiordnung von 1594]	1594	14, p. 84	468	Discipline / police	R	described in the introduction only; Friedrich IV
93	[Christliche Almosenordnung von 1594]	1594	14, p. 84	468	Poor relief	R	described in the introduction only; Friedrich IV
94	[Christliche Almosenordnung für Oberpfalz von 1599]	1599	14, p. 84	468	Poor relief	R	described in the introduction only; Friedrich IV
95	Churfürstlicher Pfaltz verneuerte almusenordnunge und, was deren anhanget [vom 12. Januar 1600]	1600	14, p. 85	468	Poor relief	R	described in the introduction only; Friedrich IV
99	[Bestallung eines Inspektors vom 22. Juli 1601]	1601	14, p. 86	468	Appointment / oath	R	described in the introduction only; Friedrich IV

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
101	[Christliche Ehe- und Ehegerichtsordnung für Oberpfalz von 1606]	1606	14, p. 87	468	Consistory / synod / government	R	described in the introduction only; Friedrich IV
102	Mandat und constitution ... [für Oberpfalz von 1606]	1606	14, p. 87	468	Mandate / decree	R	described in the introduction only; Friedrich IV
104	Bestallungspuncten, darauf ein jeder, so in der Obern churfürstlichen Pfaltz in Bayern zum kirchendienst aufgenommen wird, mit handgegebener treu an ...	1609	14, p. 88	468	School / university	R	described in the introduction only; Friedrich IV
105	Bestallungspuncten, darauf ein jeder, so in der ObernchurfürstlichenPfaltz in Bayern zum schuldienst aufgenommen wird, mit handgegebener treu an ...	1609	14, p. 88	468	School / university	R	described in the introduction only; Friedrich IV
106	[Christliche Ehe- und Ehegerichtsordnung vom 11. Juli 1610]	1610	14, p. 88	468	Consistory / synod / government	R	described in the introduction only; Friedrich IV
107	Mandat und constitution ... [vom 11. Juli 1610]	1610	14, p. 88	468	Mandate / decree	R	described in the introduction only; Friedrich IV
108	Churfürstlicher Pfaltz kirchendienerbestallungspuncten [von 1610]	1610	14, p. 89	468	Consistory / synod / government	R	described in the introduction only; Friedrich V
109	Churfürstlicher Pfaltz schuldienerbestallungspuncten [von 1610]	1610	14, p. 89	468	School / university	R	described in the introduction only; Friedrich V
110	Ordnung gewisser zusammenkunften der kirchendiener (classici conventus genant), wie es damit in dieser Obern churfürstlichen Pfaltz gehalten werden ...	1615	14, p. 89	468	Consistory / synod / government	R	described in the introduction only
1	[Edikt über die fakultative Reichung des Abendmahls unter beiderlei Gestalt, Abhaltung des Gottesdienstes und Reichung der Sakramente in deutscher ...	1546	14, p. 90	469	Agenda / liturgy	L	Friedrich II
2	Bedenken des durchleuchtigsten pfaltzgraven Friederichs, churfursten und meins gnedigsten herren auf trefflich gehalten rathe seyner churfürstlichen ...	1546	14, p. 90	469	Mandate / decree	L	Friedrich II
3	Gemaine maß, die kirchen- und gottesdinst anzurichten, biß das hierin durch kunftige visitatores und superattendenten weiter bericht gegeben würde ...	1546	14, p. 94	472	Visitation	L	Friedrich II
4	Pfaltzgrave Friedrichs, churfürsten etc., aufgerichtete ordenunge christlicher und guter policey [vom 17. Juni 1546]	1546	14, p. 102	473	Discipline / police	L	Friedrich II

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
5	Kirchenordnu[n]g, wie es mit der christlichen lehr, heiligen sacramenten und allerley andern ceremonien in meines gnedigen herrn, herrn ...	1547	14, p. 109	473	Church order	L	Friedrich II
6	[Reformationsmandat an die Amtleute, betreffend die Abschaffung des katholischen Gottesdiensts und vorläufige Ordnung des Gottesdiensts im ...	1556	14, p. 111	474	Agenda / liturgy	L	Ottheinrich
7	Kirchenordnung, wie es mit der christlichen leere, heiligen sacramenten und ceremonien in des durchleuchtigsten, hochgebornen fürsten und herren ...	1556	14, p. 113	476	Church order	L	Ottheinrich
8	Von den eesachen, wie dieselbige in des durchleuchtigisten, hochgebornen fürsten und herrn, hern Ottheinrichs, pfaltzgraven bey Rhein, des heiligen ...	n.d.	14, p. 221	481	Marriage	L	Ottheinrich
9	Schulordnung, wie dieselbige in des durchleuchtigisten, hochgebornen fürsten und herrn, hern Ottheinrichs, pfaltzgraven bey Rhein, des heiligen ...	n.d.	14, p. 225	482	School / university	L	Ottheinrich
10	[Instruktion der Kirchenräte von 1556]	1556	14, p. 229	484	Mandate / decree	L	Ottheinrich
11	[Instruktion der Spezialsuperintendenten von 1556]	1556	14, p. 231	485	Consistory / synod / government	L	Ottheinrich
12	[Instruktion der Generalsuperintendenten von 1556]	1556	14, p. 233	486	Consistory / synod / government	L	Ottheinrich
13	De electione et examine ministrorum ecclesiae [von 1556]	1556	14, p. 234	486	Other	L	Ottheinrich
14	[Bedenken des Superintendenten über Schwenckfeldianer, Wiedertäufer und andere Sekten von 1556]	1556	14, p. 236	486	Consistory / synod / government	L	Ottheinrich
15	[Bedenken der Verordneten und Generalsuperintendenten über das Verfahren mit trunksüchtigen Kirchendienern von 1556]	1556	14, p. 239	486	Consistory / synod / government	L	Ottheinrich
16	[Form der Einführung von Kirchendienern von 1556]	1556	14, p. 241	486	Consistory / synod / government	L	Ottheinrich
17	Folgen etliche nebenbedengken, wie es in andern sachen bey den kirchen und pfharhen, sonderlich mit den gemainen, auch armenkasten, gehalten mocht ...	1556	14, p. 243	487	Poor relief	L	Ottheinrich

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
18	[Visitationsinstruktion von 1556]	1556	14, p. 246	488	Visitation	L	Ottheinrich
19	[Mandat auf die gehaltene Visitation vom 22. Dezember 1556]	1556	14, p. 252	489	Visitation	L	Ottheinrich
20	[Mandat über die Entfernung der Bilder und Nebenaltäre aus den Kirchen von 1557]	1557	14, p. 254	490	Mandate / decree	L	Ottheinrich
21	[Erneuerung des Bildermandats vom 14. Dezember 1557]	1557	14, p. 255	491	Mandate / decree	L	Ottheinrich
22	[Revers und Bestallungsbrief eines Kirchendieners vom Januar 1558]	1558	14, p. 256	492	Consistory / synod / government	L	Ottheinrich
23	Instruction, weß sich unser pfaltzgrave Ottheinrichs, churfurstens etc., geordenter specialsuperintendens zu Lutzelstein, Doctor Johann Marbach …	1558	14, p. 257	492	Consistory / synod / government	L	Ottheinrich
24	[Polizeimandat gegen das Unmaß bei Hochzeiten und Kindtaufen, auch bei Banketten, vom 14. Dezember 1558]	1558	14, p. 261	493	Agenda / liturgy	L	Friedrich III
26	Pfaltzgrave Friderichs, churfürstens etc., aufgerichte christliche policeyordnung [vom 30. Juli 1562]	1562	14, p. 264	493	Discipline / police	R	Friedrich III
27	Pfaltzgrave Friderichs, churfürsten, aufgerichte christliche eheordnung [vom 30.Juli 1563]	1563	14, p. 275	495	Marriage	R	Friedrich III
29	[Ehegerichtsordnung von 1563]	1563	14, p. 289	496	Consistory / synod / government	R	Friedrich III
30	[Mandat zur erneuten Einschärfung der Polizeiordnung vom 20. September 1563]	1563	14, p. 332	497	Discipline / police	R	Friedrich III
31	Kirchenordnung, wie es mit der christlichen lehre, heiligen sacramenten und ceremonien in des durchleuchtigsten, hochgebornen fürsten und herren …	1563	14, p. 333	498	Church order	R	Friedrich III
32	[Kirchenratsordnung vom 21. Juli 1564]	1564	14, p. 409	504	Consistory / synod / government	R	Friedrich III
33	[Kirchendienerbestallung vom 21. Juli 1564]	1564	14, p. 425	504	Consistory / synod / government	R	Friedrich III
35	Ordnung des wochenlichen almusens zu Haidelberg [von etwa 1564]	1564	14, p. 428	504	Poor relief	R	Friedrich III

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
36	[Befehl an die Amtleute vom 3. Oktober 1565, in den Kirchen die Bilder, Altäre und sonstigen Kirchenzierrat abzuschaffen]	1565	14, p. 429	504	Mandate / decree	R	Friedrich III
40	[Bestallung eines Beisitzers des Kirchenrats und Aufsehers über die Druckerei vom 1. August 1566]	1566	14, p. 430	504	Consistory / synod / government	R	Friedrich III
41	[Kirchendienerbestallung, zwischen 1566 und 1570]	1570	14, p. 431	504	Consistory / synod / government	R	Friedrich III
44	[Edikt über die Einhaltung der Polizeiordnung, die Einrichtung der Kirchendisziplin und der Classicalconvente und die Verbesserung des Almosens vom ...	1570	14, p. 436	504	Consistory / synod / government	R	Friedrich III
45	[Befehl vom 9. August 1570, das Edikt vom 13. Juli 1570 über die Einhaltung der Polizeiordnung, die Einrichtung der Kirchendisziplin und der ...	1570	14, p. 441	504	Consistory / synod / government	R	Friedrich III
46	[Befehl vom 12. August 1570 gegen die Handhabung des Kirchenbanns durch die Kirchendiener und gegen Kanzelpolemik]	1570	14, p. 442	504	Consistory / synod / government	R	Friedrich III
47	Almusenordnung der statt Haydelberg [um 1570]	1570	14, p. 443	504	Poor relief	R	Friedrich III
48	[Bericht des Kirchenratspräsidenten Wenzel Zuleger an Kurfürst Friedrich III. über die Einrichtung von Classicalconventen und Presbyterien vom ...	1571	14, p. 446	504	Consistory / synod / government	R	Friedrich III
49	Verkhündung der senioren [für Rheinpfalz und die Vordere Grafschaft Sponheim vom Frühjahr 1571[	1571	14, p. 447	504	Other	R	Friedrich III
50	Officium presbyterorum [für Rheinpfalz und die Vordere Grafschaft Sponheim von 1571[	1571	14, p. 448	504	Consistory / synod / government	R	Friedrich III
51	[Bericht der Pfarrer und Theologen der Kirche und Universität zu Heidelberg über das kurpfälzische Kirchenwesen vom 25. April 1571]	1571	14, p. 450	504	School / university	R	Friedrich III
52	[Bestallung eines Glöckners vom 15. Mai 1572]	1572	14, p. 455	504	Appointment / oath	R	Friedrich III
54	Churf.[urstlicher] Pfaltz resolution uf die gemeine mengel, im synodo den 16. Maii a[nn]o etc. [15]73. zu Heidelberg fürgelaufen undt allen obern ...	n.d.	14, p. 458	504	Consistory / synod / government	R	Friedrich III
55	Pfaltzqrave Friderichs, churfürstens etc. aufgerichte christliche almusenordnung [vom 17. Februar 1574]	1574	14, p. 458	504	Poor relief	R	Friedrich III

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
56	Mandat und constitution, welcher gestalt die blutschanden, notzucht, raub oder entführung, auch ehebruch, hurerey und dergleichen laster zu strafen …	1575	14, p. 484	504	Mandate / decree	R	Friedrich III
58	Ordnung und befehlch, was unser pfaltzgrave Friderichs, churfürsten etc., verwalter und andere zugeordtnete personen über die kirchengüter und …	1576	14, p. 489	504	Property / endowment	R	Friedrich III
66	Verzeichnuß etlicher capitum, darauf ein jeder minister, so in churfürstlicher Pfaltz zu einem kirchendiener aufgenommen wirdt, anzugeloben und zu …	1580	14, p. 506	505	Consistory / synod / government	L	Ludwig VI
67	Verzeichnuß etlicher capitum, darauf ein jeder schulmeister, so in churfürstlicher Pfaltz aufgenommen wirdt, promission thun solle etc. [von 1580]	1580	14, p. 508	505	School / university	L	Ludwig VI
80	Pfaltzgraf Johann Casimirs etc., vormunds und der churfürstlichen Pfaltz administrators etc. mandat und befelch, daß bey etlichen kirchen und schuln …	1584	14, p. 510	506	School / university	R	Johann Casimir as administrator
83	[Kirchenratsordnung vom 6. September 1585]	1585	14, p. 515	507	Consistory / synod / government	R	Johann Casimir as administrator
84	Verzeichnus etlicher bestallungspuncten, darauf ein jeder, so in churfürstlicher Pfaltz zum Kirchendienst aufgenommen wirdt, mit handtgegebner treu …	1586	14, p. 524	508	School / university	R	Johann Casimir as administrator
85	Ordo, so in conventibus classicis hinfuro zu halten [vom Mai 1587]	1587	14, p. 527	509	Consistory / synod / government	R	Johann Casimir as administrator
86	[Bestallung eines Inspektors vom 2. Juni 1587]	1587	14, p. 534	510	Appointment / oath	R	Johann Casimir as administrator
87	[Revers und Bestallung eines Kirchenrats vom 1. Januar 1588]	1588	14, p. 541	511	Consistory / synod / government	R	Johann Casimir as administrator
91	[Kirchenratsordnung, wohl von 1593]	1593	14, p. 544	513	Consistory / synod / government	R	Friedrich IV
96	Kirchenordnung, wie es mit der christlichen lehre, heyligen sacramenten und ceremonien in des durchleuchtigsten, hochgebornen fürsten und herrn …	1601	14, p. 556	514	Church order	R	Friedrich IV
97	Churfürstlicher Pfaltz kirchendienerbestallungspuncten [vom 4. Juli 1601]	1601	14, p. 586	515	Consistory / synod / government	R	Friedrich IV

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
98	Churfürstlicher Pfaltz schuldienerbestallungspuncten [vom 4. Juli 1601]	1601	14, p. 591	516	School / university	R	Friedrich IV
100	Presbyteri- oder altistenordnung, wie es damit in churfurstlicher Pfaltz gehalten werden soll [wohl von 1601]	1601	14, p. 593	517	Consistory / synod / government	R	Friedrich IV
103	Ordnung gewisser zusammenkunften der kirchendiener (classici conventus genandt), wie es damit in churfürstlicher Pfaltz gehalten werden soll [vom 6. …	1607	14, p. 604	519	Consistory / synod / government	R	Friedrich IV

1.23 Volume 15: Württemberg I: County of Hohenlohe

108 texts.

1.23.1 County of Hohenlohe

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
1	Bestallung des ersten evangelischen Predigers Caspar Huberinus am 25. April und 12. Mai 1544 (Ö) 1	1544	15, p. 23	532	Appointment / oath	L	
2	Liederliste der Öhringer Stiftskirche (ab 1544/1546) <Ö>	1546	15, p. 28	534	Monastery / chapter	L	
3	Vermahnungen und Gebete für den Gottesdienst in Öhringen 1544-1550 <Ö>	1550	15, p. 31	535	Agenda / liturgy	L	
4	Eine ordnung, wie es in der schuell zue Öringen gehalten möchte werden. 6. Eebruar 1549 <Ö>	1549	15, p. 45	537	School / university	L	
5	Christliche kirchenordnung der graveschaft Hohennloe etc. 1553	1553	15, p. 53	538	Church order	L	
6	Polizeiordnung vom 27. Januar 1556	1556	15, p. 82	540	Discipline / police	L	
7	Bestallung und Revers von Pfarrern 1556	1556	15, p. 88	541	Appointment / oath	L	
7a	Bestallung des Prädikanten David Püttner vom 5. März 1556	1556	15, p. 89	542	Appointment / oath	L	
7b	Revers von Veit Kestner in Münster von 1556	1556	15, p. 90	542	Appointment / oath	L	
8	Durchführung der Reformation 1556	1556	15, p. 93	543	Other	L	
8a	Befehl, zur Bekanntgabe der Reformation zu erscheinen, vom 21. Mai 1556	1556	15, p. 95	543	Mandate / decree	L	
8b	Eragstück, daruf die pfarherren und geforderte personen in der examination und inquisition	1556	15, p. 95	543	Other	L	

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
	sollen gefragt werden. 9. Juni 1556						
9	Reformation und Ordnung des Öhringer Stifts 1556 <Ö>	1556	15, p. 97	544	Church order	L	
9a	Bericht über die Beratung in Öhringen im Februar 1556	1556	15, p. 99	545	Mandate / decree	L	
9b	Waldenburger Bedenken vom 10. September 1556	1556	15, p. 101	545	Mandate / decree	L	
9c	Verzeichnus, wie es in den stiftskirchen mit singen und lesen soll gehalten werden etc	n.d.	15, p. 103	545	Monastery / chapter	L	
10	Stipendiatenreverse ab 1556 <Ö, H>	1556	15, p. 105	546	School / university	L	
11	Pfarrpräsentationsordnung	n.d.	15, p. 111	548	Other	L	
11a	Ordrrang, wie die neuen pfarrherrn der ldrchen fürgestelt nnd ihnen anß befelch nnßerer gnädigen herrschaft das pfarrampt befohlen soll werden	n.d.	15, p. 112	548	Mandate / decree	L	
11h	Präsentationsbefehl vom 14. März 1572 <N)	1572	15, p. 114	548	Mandate / decree	L	
12	Visitation 1558	1558	15, p. 116	549	Visitation	L	
12a	Visitations- nnd Kirchenordnnng von 1558 <H, Wa>	1558	15, p. 120	549	Visitation	L	
12b	Waldenbnrger Generalartikel nach der Visitation	n.d.	15, p. 132	549	Visitation	L	
13	Polizeiordnung vom 26. September 1558	1558	15, p. 134	550	Discipline / police	L	
14	Befehl wegen Besuch von Gottesdiensten, Beerdigungen und Almosen (um 1558)	1558	15, p. 146	551	Mandate / decree	L	
15	Befehl wegen der Bettler nnd des Almosens vom 10. Januar 1562	1562	15, p. 148	552	Mandate / decree	L	
16	Testament Graf Lndwig Casimirs vom 29. Juli 1564	1564	15, p. 150	554	Other	L	
17	Polizeiordnung vom 19. Februar 1571	1571	15, p. 155	555	Discipline / police	L	
18	Visitation 1571	1571	15, p. 159	556	Visitation	L	
18a	Visitation 1571 : Visitationsinstruktion vom 20. Mai 1571	1571	15, p. 161	556	Visitation	L	
18b	Visitation 1571 : Visitationspatent vom 20. Mai 1571	1571	15, p. 166	556	Visitation	L	

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
18c	Ordnung, welche allen pfarherrn ubergeben worden	n.d.	15, p. 167	556	Local order	L	
18d	Der herschaft bevelch an die pfarrher, haltung der freytagspredig	n.d.	15, p. 169	556	Other	L	
19	Eheordnung vom 6. November 1572	1572	15, p. 171	557	Marriage	L	
19a	Eheordnung vom 6. November 1572 : Eheordnung (Langfassung)	1572	15, p. 174	559	Marriage	L	
19b	Eheordnung vom 6. November 1572 : Summarische Eheordnung (Kurzfassung)	1572	15, p. 200	559	Marriage	L	
20	Kanzleiordnung vom 16. August 1574	1574	15, p. 207	560	Other	L	
21	Registratorenordnung vom 22. Februar 1575 (mit Änderungen)	1575	15, p. 214	563	Other	L	
22	Reverse der Pfarrer von Hollenbach und Adolzhausen an den Deutschen Orden seit dem Januar 1578	1578	15, p. 221	566	Appointment / oath	L	
23	Kirchenordnung, die im Amt Schillingsfürst bis 1578 gehalten wurde	1578	15, p. 226	567	Church order	L	
24	Verbot cles Weinschenkens für die Öhringer Kirchendiener vom 3. Juni 1578 <Ö>	1578	15, p. 228	568	Mandate / decree	L	
25	Kirchenordnung 1578	1578	15, p. 230	569	Church order	L	
25a	Kirchenordnung 1578	1578	15, p. 254	574	Church order	L	
25b	Befehl an clie Amtsdiener bei Einführung der Kirchenordnung vom 6. Oktober 1578 <Ö, N>	1578	15, p. 352	574	Church order	L	
25c	Befehl für Öhringen wegen des Katechismus und der Bibliothek vom 24. August 1579 <Ö>	1579	15, p. 353	574	Mandate / decree	L	
26	Kapitels- und Visitationsorclnung vom 12. April 1579	1579	15, p. 354	575	Visitation	L	
27	Konsistorialordnung vom 21. Mai 1579	1579	15, p. 383	579	Consistory / synod / government	L	
28	Verbot der öffentlichen Kirchenzucht vom 1. Eebruar 1580	1580	15, p. 407	583	Mandate / decree	L	
29	Visitation 1581	1581	15, p. 410	584	Visitation	L	
29a	Visitationsinstruktion vom 2./5. Januar 1581	1581	15, p. 414	584	Visitation	L	

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
29b	Visitation 1581 : Visitationspatent	1581	15, p. 419	584	Visitation	L	
29c	Befehl an clie Spezialsuperintendenten, wie sie ihre eigenen Pfarreien visitieren sollen, vom 9. Februar 1581	1581	15, p. 420	584	Mandate / decree	L	
29d	Wie es der außlendischen pfarren halben mit der visitation gehalten werden soll	n.d.	15, p. 421	584	Visitation	L	
30	Befehl bei Übersendung des Konkordienbuches vom 19. März 1581 <Ö>	1581	15, p. 424	585	Mandate / decree	L	
31	Befehl nach der Visitation für Öhringen (nach dem 5. November 1581) <Ö>	1581	15, p. 426	586	Mandate / decree	L	
32	Kirchen- uncl Schulordnungen 1582	1582	15, p. 433	587	School / university	L	
33	Polizei- und Eheordnung vom 16. Januar 1583	1583	15, p. 509	593	Marriage	L	
34	Befehl wegen Länge cler Predigten vom 25. Juli 1585	1585	15, p. 519	597	Mandate / decree	L	
35	Verbot der Kirchweihen, des Spielens und Tanzens vom 13. Mai 1586	1586	15, p. 521	598	Mandate / decree	L	
36	Amtsordming vom 22. Februar 1587	1587	15, p. 523	599	Other	L	
37	Fragen über die Kirchenzeremonien vom Juni 1587	1587	15, p. 531	601	Agenda / liturgy	L	
38	Neuensteiner Befehle in Kriegsgefahr, besonders wegen des täglichen Gebetsgottesdienstes vom 1. Februar 1588 bis 14. August 1594	1594	15, p. 536	603	Agenda / liturgy	L	
38a	Befehl an die Kirchendiener wegen eines Gebets in den Gottesdiensten uncl cles täglichen Gebets vom 1. Februar 1588	1588	15, p. 538	604	Mandate / decree	L	
38b	Christlich gebett zur zeit cler kriegsleuf und feindesnot	n.d.	15, p. 540	604	Agenda / liturgy	L	
38c	Befehl an die Amtsdiener wegen der Freitagspredigten, des täglichen Gebets uncl der Abschaffung von Fressen und Saufen vom 1. Februar 1588	1588	15, p. 541	604	Mandate / decree	L	
38d	Befehl an die Amtsdiener, besonders gegen Fressen uncl von Saufen von 1588	1588	15, p. 542	604	Mandate / decree	L	
38e	Befehl an die Kirchendiener wegen Läutens der Türkenglocken und cles täglichen Gebets vom 18. August 1594	1594	15, p. 544	604	Mandate / decree	L	
38f	Befehl an die Amtscliener wegen Läutens der Tiirkenglocken, des täglichen Gebets und cler	1594	15, p. 546	604	Mandate / decree	L	

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
	Abschaffung von Fressen und Saufen vom 21. August 1594						
39	Weikersheimer Befehle wegen der Eheverkündigung, der Beichtpfennige und cles täglichen Gebetsgottesdienstes vom 23. April 1588 bis 18. Mai 1588	1588	15, p. 548	605	Agenda / liturgy	L	
39a	Befehl an den Weikersheimer Superintendenten wegen der Eheverkündigung und der Beichtpfennige vom 23. April 1588	1588	15, p. 549	605	Mandate / decree	L	
39b	Befehl an die Pfarrer wegen des täglichen Gebets, der Eheverkündigung und cler Beichtpfennige vom 24. April 1588	1588	15, p. 549	605	Mandate / decree	L	
39c	Instruction, wie das alltäglich gebet, so in diser herrschaft angerichtet werden soll, den gemeinen furzuhalten uncl zu commenclieren	n.d.	15, p. 550	605	Agenda / liturgy	L	
	cl) Gebet in Feindes- und anderen Nöten	n.d.	15, p. 552	605	Agenda / liturgy	L	
39e	Befehl an clen Ingelfinger Keller wegen des täglichen Gebets vom 1. Mai 1588	1588	15, p. 553	605	Mandate / decree	L	
39f	Befehl an den Ingelfinger Superintendenten wegen des täglichen Gebets vom 18. Mai 1588	1588	15, p. 553	605	Mandate / decree	L	
40	Langenburger Gebet in Kriegszeiten von 1588	1588	15, p. 554	606	Agenda / liturgy	L	
41	Gemeinsame Beschlüsse der Neuensteiner Linie vom 22. Juni 1588	1588	15, p. 555	607	Other	L	
42	Eicle, Reserve und Bestallungen der Kirchendiener ab 1588	1588	15, p. 559	608	Consistory / synod / government	L	
42a	Eid der gemeinsamen Kirchendiener von 1588 <0, N>	1588	15, p. 562	608	Consistory / synod / government	L	
42b	Revers und Bestallung für clie Herrschaft Weikersheim von 1590	1590	15, p. 563	608	Appointment / oath	L	
42c	Reverse und Bestallungen für Öhringen uncl clie Herrschaft Weikersheim ab 1595 <Ö, Wk>	1595	15, p. 567	608	Appointment / oath	L	
42d	Bestimmung über Bestallungen und Reverse aus der Waldenburger Hofordnung vom Mai 1594	1594	15, p. 570	609	Appointment / oath	L	
43	Polizei- und Rügordnung vom 25. September 1588 <Wk, N>	1588	15, p. 571	610	Discipline / police	L	
44	Einführung der Gesangsordnung vom 2. Februar 1589	1589	15, p. 596	614	Agenda / liturgy	L	
44a	Befehl bei Einführung der Gesangsordnung vom 2. Februar 1589	1589	15, p. 596	614	Mandate / decree	L	

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
44b	Befehl wegen des Gesangs beim Katechismusgottesclienst vom. 17. Februar 1589	1589	15, p. 597	614	Mandate / decree	L	
45	Visitationsordnung vom 26. März 1589 <Wk, Ö>	1589	15, p. 598	615	Visitation	L	
46	Befehl wegen des Almosens vom 4. September 1589	1589	15, p. 616	620	Mandate / decree	L	
47	Befehl zum Besuch des Katechismusunterrichts in cler Passionszeit vom 7. März 1590	1590	15, p. 619	621	Mandate / decree	L	
48	Befehle wegen der Chorröcke und Tüchlein beim Abendmahl von 1590 uncl 1595	1595	15, p. 621	622	Mandate / decree	L	
48a	Befehl an die Pfarrer wegen der Chorröcke und Tüchlein beim Abendmahl vom 30. November 1590	1590	15, p. 621	622	Mandate / decree	L	
48b	Bcfehl an den Keller von Ingelfingen wegen cler Chorröcke nnd der Tüchlein beim Abenclmahl vom 2. Jnli 1595	1595	15, p. 622	622	Other	L	
49	Eheverkündignng, wenn sich jemancl in katholische Orte verheiratet (vor dem 1. Jnni 1592)	1592	15, p. 623	623	Marriage	L	
50	Befehle znr Einführung kirchlicher Ordnnngen im Amt Langenbnrg vom 1. Juni 1592	1592	15, p. 624	624	Mandate / decree	L	
50a	Befehl zur Einführung kirchlicher Orclnungen an clen Pfarrer von Langenbnrg vom Juni 1592	1592	15, p. 625	624	Mandate / decree	L	
1b	Befehl znr Einführung kirchlicher Ordnungen an clie Eorfpfarrer im Amt Langenburg vom 1. Jnni 1592	1592	15, p. 626	624	Mandate / decree	L	
51	Verbot des Verschleierns der Erauen beim Abendmahl vom 11. August 1592	1592	15, p. 627	625	Mandate / decree	L	
52	Öhringer Spitalordnung vom 2. Januar 1594 <Ö>	1594	15, p. 629	626	Poor relief	L	
53	Befehl wegen des Kirchengesangs, der Precligtlänge und der Schulvisitation vom 23. November 1594	1594	15, p. 639	627	Mandate / decree	L	
54	Schul- und Gesangsordnung samt Verbesserungen der Kirchenzeremonien vom 22. Eezember 1596	1596	15, p. 641	628	Agenda / liturgy	L	
54a	Unser Wolffgangs, ... schuel- und gesangsordnung ... <Wk, lST >	n.d.	15, p. 649	628	Agenda / liturgy	L	
54b	Übersendung der Ordnung an die Superintendenten am 26. Eezember 1596	1596	15, p. 664	629	Consistory / synod / government	L	

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
54c	Schreiben wegen Eurchführung der Ordnung vom 24. Januar 1597	1597	15, p. 665	630	Other	L	
55	Kirchenzucht wegen vorehelicher Beziehungen vom 3. Eezember 1601	1601	15, p. 666	631	Discipline / police	L	
56	Erb- und Teilungsverträge 1609-1615	1615	15, p. 668	632	Other	L	
56a	Erb- und Teilungsverträge 1609-1615: Neue Erbeinigung vom 26. Juni 1609	1609	15, p. 671	633	Treaty / agreement	L	
56b	Neuensteiner Informationslibell vom 31. Januar 1610	1610	15, p. 673	633	Other	L	
56c	Waldenburger Regimentsordnungsrezeß vom 3. Eezember 1615	1615	15, p. 677	633	Other	L	

1.24 Volume 16: Baden-Württemberg II: Württemberg, Baden, Limpurg

108 texts.

1.24.1 Duchy of Württemberg (with Mömpelgard and Horburg)

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.
- **Note**: The Interim was imposed 1548-1552.
- **Interim**: 5 text(s) tied to the Augsburg Interim (see the last column).

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
1	Mandat zur Anstellung evangelischer Geistlicher 1534	1534	16, p. 74	645	Mandate / decree	L	
2	Mandat zur Anstellung evangelischer Prediger in den Klöstern 1535	1535	16, p. 75	646	Mandate / decree	L	
3	Klosterordnung [1535]	1535	16, p. 76	647	Monastery / chapter	L	
4	Reversformulare für austretende Konventualen [um 1535]	1535	16, p. 81	647	Consistory / synod / government	L	
5	Entwurf einer Eheordnung 1535	1535	16, p. 83	648	Marriage	L	
6	Eheordnung [1536]	1536	16, p. 92	649	Marriage	L	
7	Kastenordnung 1536	1536	16, p. 95	650	Poor relief	L	
8	Kirchenordnung 1536	1536	16, p. 103	651	Church order	L	
9	Vorrede und Artikel zur Kirchenordnung 1536	1536	16, p. 129	652	Church order	L	
10	Visitationsordnung [1535]	1535	16, p. 136	653	Visitation	L	
11	Visitationsinstruktion [1536]	1536	16, p. 140	654	Visitation	L	

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
12	Mandat zum Pfarrerexamen 1538	1538	16, p. 143	655	Mandate / decree	L	
13	Bildermandat 1540	1540	16, p. 144	656	Mandate / decree	L	
14	Mandat zur Entfernung von Altären und Anschaffung deutscher Bibeln 1540	1540	16, p. 145	657	Mandate / decree	L	
15	Ordnung des Zisterzienserklosters Mariäkron in Rechentshofen 1539	1539	16, p. 146	658	Monastery / chapter	L	
16	Visitationsordnung 1547	1547	16, p. 149	659	Visitation	L	
17	Synodalordnung 1547	1547	16, p. 157	660	Consistory / synod / government	L	
18	Interimsmandat 1548	1548	16, p. 166	661	Mandate / decree	L	**Interim order**
19	Mandat zur Wiederanstellung evangelischer Prediger 1549	1549	16, p. 168	662	Mandate / decree	L	**Under the Interim**
20	Kirchenratsmandat 1548	1548	16, p. 169	663	Consistory / synod / government	L	**Under the Interim**
21	Zuchtordnung für Horburg und Reichenweier 1546	1546	16, p. 171	664	Discipline / police	L	
22	Kirchenordnung für Mömpelgard [1537/38]	1537	16, p. 175	665	Church order	L	
23a	Ordnung der Prädikantenanstellung in Mömpelgard 1545	1545	16, p. 188	665	Appointment / oath	L	
23b	Eid der Prädikanten in Mömpelgard 1545	1545	16, p. 189	665	Appointment / oath	L	
23c	Examensartikel für die Mömpelgarder und Blamonter Kirchendiener 1546	1546	16, p. 190	665	Articles / statutes	L	
23d	Examensartikel für die Mömpelgarder Kirchendiener 1552	1552	16, p. 192	665	Articles / statutes	L	
24	Artikel für den Mömpelgarder Klerus 1545	1545	16, p. 194	666	Articles / statutes	L	
25	Predigtmandat 1550	1550	16, p. 197	667	Mandate / decree	L	**Under the Interim**
26	Mandat zur Abschaffung der Messe 1552	1552	16, p. 198	668	Mandate / decree	L	**End of the Interim**
27	Mandat gegen Aufnahme von Novizen in den Klöstern 1552	1552	16, p. 199	669	Mandate / decree	L	
28	Kastenordnung 1552	1552	16, p. 200	670	Poor relief	L	

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
29	Kirchenordnung 1553	1553	16, p. 223	671	Church order	L	
30	Eheordnung 1553	1553	16, p. 277	672	Marriage	L	
31	Instruktion zur Kirchendienerbesoldung [um 1553]	1553	16, p. 284	673	Consistory / synod / government	L	
32	Mandat zur Kirchendienerbesoldung und Besetzung vakanter Stellen 1554	1554	16, p. 286	674	Mandate / decree	L	
33	Visitationsordnung 1553	1553	16, p. 287	675	Visitation	L	
34	Mandat zur Abschaffung von Feld- und zum Erhalt von Predigtkirchen 1555	1555	16, p. 292	676	Mandate / decree	L	
35	Mandat zur Abschaffung von Monstranzen, Weihwassersteinen, Bildern 1555	1555	16, p. 293	677	Mandate / decree	L	
36a	Klosterordnung 1556: Protokoll der Prälatenversammlung	1556	16, p. 294	677	Other	L	
36b	Klosterordnung 1556: Ordnung für Männerklöster	1556	16, p. 296	677	Monastery / chapter	L	
36c	Klosterordnung 1556: Ordnung für Frauenklöster	1556	16, p. 304	677	Monastery / chapter	L	
37	Statuten für das Zisterzienserkloster Herrenalb 1556	1556	16, p. 317	678	Monastery / chapter	L	
38	Investiturordnung für evangelische Prälaten [nach 1556]	1556	16, p. 321	679	Agenda / liturgy	L	
39	Visitationsartikel [um 1556/57]	1556	16, p. 324	680	Visitation	L	
40	Mandat zur Entfernung von Sakramentshäuschen 1556	1556	16, p. 325	681	Mandate / decree	L	
41	Visitationsordnung 1557	1557	16, p. 326	682	Visitation	L	
42	Große Kirchenordnung 1559, Vorrede	1559	16, p. 344	683	Church order	L	
42a	Ordnung der Besetzung von Kirchendienerstellen	n.d.	16, p. 347	683	Consistory / synod / government	L	
42b	Große Kirchenordnung 1559, Vorrede: Ordnung der Klosterschulen	1559	16, p. 361	683	School / university	L	
42c	Ordnung gegen die Täufer und andere abweichende Lehren	n.d.	16, p. 381	683	Discipline / police	L	
42d	Visitationsordnung für die Superintendenten	n.d.	16, p. 385	683	Visitation	L	

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
42e	Große Kirchenordnung 1559, Vorrede: Ordnung der politischen Visitation	1559	16, p. 395	683	Visitation	L	
42f	Große Kirchenordnung 1559, Vorrede: Landinspektion	1559	16, p. 399	683	Other	L	
42g	Große Kirchenordnung 1559, Vorrede: Ordnung der Kirchenzensur	1559	16, p. 404	683	Church order	L	
42h	Ordnung des Konvents der Superintendenten	n.d.	16, p. 408	683	Consistory / synod / government	L	
42i	Unterhaltsordnung für Kirchendiener, Schulen und Pädagogium	n.d.	16, p. 410	683	Consistory / synod / government	L	
42k	Große Kirchenordnung 1559, Vorrede: Ordnung des Kirchenrats	1559	16, p. 413	683	Consistory / synod / government	L	
43	Bekenntnis der württembergischen Theologen zum Abendmahl 1560	1560	16, p. 420	684	Confession / doctrine	L	
44	Eid der Kirchendiener [nach 1559]	1559	16, p. 424	685	Consistory / synod / government	L	
45	Hofkirchenordnung 1560	1560	16, p. 426	686	Church order	L	
46	Instruktion für die Superintendenten 1561	1561	16, p. 429	687	Consistory / synod / government	L	
47	Mandat zu Feiertagen und Taufzeremonie [um 1560]	1560	16, p. 435	688	Mandate / decree	L	
48	Abendmahlsmandat 1562	1562	16, p. 436	689	Agenda / liturgy	L	
49	Instruktion für die evangelischen Prälaten [1563]	1563	16, p. 437	690	Mandate / decree	L	
50	Büchermandat 1564	1564	16, p. 442	691	Discipline / police	L	
51	Mandat zur Unterzeichnung der Konkordienformel 1577	1577	16, p. 444	692	Mandate / decree	L	
52	Kirchenratsordnung 1569/1578	1578	16, p. 446	693	Consistory / synod / government	L	
53	Große Kirchenordnung 1582, Vorrede	1582	16, p. 460	694	Church order	L	
54	Ehegerichtsordnung 1586	1586	16, p. 462	695	Consistory / synod / government	L	
55	Büchermandat 1593	1593	16, p. 468	696	Discipline / police	L	
56	Visitationsinstruktion für die Spezialsuperintendenten 1597	1597	16, p. 470	697	Visitation	L	

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
57	Verbot der Eheschließung von Protestanten mit Katholiken 1609	1609	16, p. 472	698	Mandate / decree	L	
58	Mandat zur Kastenordnung 1614	1614	16, p. 473	699	Mandate / decree	L	

1.24.2 Margraviate of Baden

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
1	Kirchenordnung 1533	1533	16, p. 499	702	Church order	L	
2	Klostermandat 1528	1528	16, p. 512	703	Monastery / chapter	L	
3	Wiedertäufermandat 1543	1543	16, p. 513	704	Discipline / police	L	
4	Kirchenzuchtmandat 1548	1548	16, p. 517	705	Discipline / police	L	
5	Kirchenordnung 1556	1556	16, p. 519	706	Church order	L	
6	Visitationsordnung 1556	1556	16, p. 522	707	Visitation	L	
7	Kollaturvertrag 1561	1561	16, p. 528	708	Treaty / agreement	L	
8	Pfarrhausmandat 1564	1564	16, p. 532	709	Mandate / decree	L	
9	Kirchenzuchtordnung 1564	1564	16, p. 533	710	Discipline / police	L	
10	Kirchenordnungsmandat Lahr 1567	1567	16, p. 539	711	Church order	L	
11	Eheordnung 1581	1581	16, p. 540	712	Marriage	L	
12	Kirchenordnungsmandat 1601	1601	16, p. 551	713	Church order	L	
13	Dienstleutemandat 1602	1602	16, p. 556	714	Mandate / decree	L	
14	Kirchenordnungsmandate 1603	1603	16, p. 557	715	Church order	L	
15	Ehebruchmandat 1604	1604	16, p. 563	716	Marriage	L	
16	Toleranzmandat 1608	1608	16, p. 570	717	Mandate / decree	L	

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
17	Sonntagsmandat 1609	1609	16, p. 571	718	Discipline / police	L	
18	Fastnachtsmandat 1610	1610	16, p. 572	719	Discipline / police	L	
19	Predigtmandat 1610	1610	16, p. 573	720	Mandate / decree	L	
20	Jesuitenmandat 1611	1611	16, p. 574	721	Mandate / decree	L	
21	Mandat zum Reformationsjubiläum 1617	1617	16, p. 576	722	Mandate / decree	L	

1.24.3 County of Limpurg

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
1	Pfarrstellenbesetzungsrevers 1537	1537	16, p. 589	725	Appointment / oath	L	
2	Eheordnung 1573	1573	16, p. 591	726	Marriage	L	
2b	Eheordnung 1573: Extrakt der Eheordnung 1610	1610	16, p. 603	726	Marriage	L	
3	Ordinationsordnung 1590	1590	16, p. 607	727	Agenda / liturgy	L	
4	Kirchenbußmandat 1596	1596	16, p. 609	728	Agenda / liturgy	L	
5	Kirchenordnung 1610	1610	16, p. 610	729	Church order	L	
6	Visitationsordnung 1611	1611	16, p. 625	730	Visitation	L	
7	Ehebruchmandat 1614	1614	16, p. 632	731	Marriage	L	
8	Kirchenbußordnung 1620	1620	16, p. 634	732	Agenda / liturgy	L	

1.24.4 Lordship of Kinzigtal (Fürstenberg)

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
1	Sieben Artikel 1542	1542	16, p. 644	735	Other	L	
2	Kompetenzmandat 1542	1542	16, p. 646	736	Mandate / decree	L	

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
3	Landesordnung 1543 (Auszug)	1543	16, p. 647	737	Discipline / police	L	
4	Visitationsmandat 1546	1546	16, p. 650	738	Visitation	L	

1.24.5 Lordship of Neckarbischofsheim

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
	Kirchenordnung 1560	1560	16, p. 657	741	Church order	L	

1.25 Volume 17/1: Baden-Württemberg III/1: Hall, Heilbronn, Konstanz, Isny, Gengenbach

78 texts.

1.25.1 Imperial city of Schwäbisch Hall

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.
- **Note**: Hall kept the Interim order until 1559.
- **Interim**: 2 text(s) tied to the Augsburg Interim (see the last column).

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
1	Frühmessordnung 1526	1526	17/1, p. 37	754	Other	L	
2	Kirchenordnung 1527	1527	17/1, p. 42	755	Church order	L	
3	Ordnung der Gottesdienste an Werk- und Feiertagen sowie bei Eheeinsegnungen [1527]	1527	17/1, p. 66	756	Agenda / liturgy	L	
4a	Sitten- und Kirchenzuchtmandate [1527]: Ordnung gegen Gotteslästerung, Trunksucht und Kuppelei	1527	17/1, p. 71	756	Discipline / police	L	
4b	Sitten- und Kirchenzuchtmandate [1527]: Einfiihrungspredigt zur Ordnung gegen Gotteslästerung u.a	1527	17/1, p. 74	756	Discipline / police	L	
4c	Sitten- und Kirchenzuchtmandate [1527]: Einführungspredigt zum Feiertagsmandat	1527	17/1, p. 77	756	Discipline / police	L	
5	Katechismus für Schwäbisch Hall [1528]	1528	17/1, p. 81	757	Catechism / instruction	L	
6	Katechismus für Schwäbisch Hall 1535	1535	17/1, p. 93	758	Catechism / instruction	L	
7	Sendordnung 1531	1531	17/1, p. 96	759	Other	L	
8	Entwurf einer Gottesdienstordnung für die Haller Landgemeinde Bibersfeld 1535	1535	17/1, p. 101	760	Agenda / liturgy	L	

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
9	Agende für das Krankenabendmahl 1537	1537	17/1, p. 103	761	Agenda / liturgy	L	
10	Kirchenordnung 1543/1615	1615	17/1, p. 111	762	Church order	L	
11	Ordnung der Feiertage 1545	1545	17/1, p. 192	763	Discipline / police	L	
12a	Täufermandate: Verbot, sich den Täufern anzuschließen 1545	1545	17/1, p. 193	763	Mandate / decree	L	
12b	Täufermandate: Verbot, mit den Täufern Handel zu treiben 1548	1548	17/1, p. 195	763	Mandate / decree	L	**Under the Interim**
12c	Täufermandate: Einzug der Täufergüter durch den Rat 1576	1576	17/1, p. 196	763	Discipline / police	L	
13	Statuten des Landkapitels [1553]	1553	17/1, p. 197	763	Consistory / synod / government	L	**Under the Interim**
14	Eheordnung 1559	1559	17/1, p. 201	763	Marriage	L	
15	Auszug aus der Eheordnung 1570/1599	1599	17/1, p. 205	763	Marriage	L	
16	Anleitung zum Beichtunterricht 1574	1574	17/1, p. 209	763	Catechism / instruction	L	
17	Ordnung gegen Trunksucht, Fluchen, Schwören, Ehebruch und Hurerei 1599	1599	17/1, p. 213	763	Marriage	L	

1.25.2 Imperial city of Heilbronn

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
1	Ratsbeschluss zur Zulassung des evangelischen Abendmahls 1528	1528	17/1, p. 236	766	Mandate / decree	L	
2	Mandat zu Abendmahl und Katechismusunterricht 1528	1528	17/1, p. 237	767	Mandate / decree	L	
3	Heilbronner Katechismus 1528	1528	17/1, p. 238	768	Catechism / instruction	L	
4	Entwurf einer Ordnung der Sittenzucht und der Feiertage [1529/30]	1529	17/1, p. 269	769	Discipline / police	L	
5	„Confessio Heilbronnensis“ und Kirchenordnung 1530	1530	17/1, p. 273	770	Confession / doctrine	L	
6	Eid des Heilbronner Rates auf den neuen Glauben 1530	1530	17/1, p. 290	771	Appointment / oath	L	

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
7	Ratsprotokoll zur Abschaffung der Messe 1531	1531	17/1, p. 292	772	Agenda / liturgy	L	
8	Instruktion zur Abstimmung der Gemeinde über die Messfeier 1531	1531	17/1, p. 293	773	Mandate / decree	L	
9	Mandat zur Abschaffung der Messe unter den Präsenzherren 1531	1531	17/1, p. 295	774	Mandate / decree	L	
10	Instruktion zur Abschaffung der Messe im Klarissenkloster 1531	1531	17/1, p. 297	775	Agenda / liturgy	L	
11	Instruktion zur Zusammenlegung beider Beginenhäuser 1531	1531	17/1, p. 298	776	Mandate / decree	L	
12	Verbot von Eheprozessen vor geistlichen Gerichten 1531	1531	17/1, p. 299	777	Mandate / decree	L	
13	Entwurf einer Gottesdienstordnung 1532	1532	17/1, p. 300	778	Agenda / liturgy	L	
14	Gottesdienstordnung 1532	1532	17/1, p. 304	779	Agenda / liturgy	L	
15	Statuten zum Eherecht 1541	1541	17/1, p. 307	780	Marriage	L	
16	Kirchenordnung 1543	1543	17/1, p. 313	781	Church order	L	
17	Ordnung des Kirchengesangs [1543]	1543	17/1, p. 320	782	Agenda / liturgy	L	
18	Kirchenordnung 1603	1603	17/1, p. 327	783	Church order	L	

1.25.3 Imperial city of Konstanz

- **Tradition**: Moderate Reformed.
- **Note**: Upper German (Zwick, Blarer); the Reformation ended when Konstanz fell to Austria in 1548.

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
1	Reformationsratschlag für den Städtetag in Ulm 1524	1524	17/1, p. 347	786	Other	MR	
2a	Konstanzer Reformationsordnung 1524-1529: Predigtmandat 1524	1524	17/1, p. 362	786	Mandate / decree	MR	
2b	Konstanzer Reformationsordnung 1524-1529: Edikt gegen Ehebruch und Hurerei 1527	1527	17/1, p. 363	786	Mandate / decree	MR	
2c	Konstanzer Reformationsordnung 1524-1529: Ordnung der Eheeinsegnungen [1528]	1528	17/1, p. 364	786	Marriage	MR	
2d	Konstanzer Reformationsordnung 1524-1529: Ordnung der Taufen [um 1529]	1529	17/1, p. 366	786	Agenda / liturgy	MR	

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
2e	Konstanzer Reformationsordnung 1524-1529: Ordnung der Feiertage 1527	1527	17/1, p. 368	786	Discipline / police	MR	
3	Ausschreiben gegen Fluchen, Gotteslästerung und Zutrinken [1526]	1526	17/1, p. 370	787	Mandate / decree	MR	
4	Almosenordnung 1527	1527	17/1, p. 372	788	Poor relief	MR	
5	Almosenordnung 1532	1532	17/1, p. 378	789	Poor relief	MR	
6	Almosenordnung 1545	1545	17/1, p. 381	790	Poor relief	MR	
7	Mandat zur Eheschließung Minderjähriger, vor 5. April 1531	1531	17/1, p. 383	790	Mandate / decree	MR	
8	Zuchtordnung 1531	1531	17/1, p. 384	790	Discipline / police	MR	
9	Mandat zur Feiertagsheiligung 1531	1531	17/1, p. 410	790	Mandate / decree	MR	
10	Abschaffung der Klöpfleinsnächte 1535	1535	17/1, p. 411	790	Mandate / decree	MR	
11	Abschaffung des Neujahrsansingens 1544	1544	17/1, p. 412	790	Mandate / decree	MR	
12	Verbot, Hunde während des Gottesdienstes in der Kirche herumlaufen zu lassen 1537	1537	17/1, p. 413	790	Mandate / decree	MR	
13	Strafen gegen Hunde, die während des Gottesdienstes in der Kirche herumlaufen 1543	1543	17/1, p. 414	790	Agenda / liturgy	MR	
14	Ordnung der Eheaufgebote und Eheeinsegnungen 1537/1543/1548	1548	17/1, p. 415	791	Marriage	MR	
15	Ordnung der Kirchenpflege [1538]	1538	17/1, p. 416	792	Church order	MR	

1.25.4 Imperial city of Isny

- **Tradition**: Moderate Reformed; Lutheran from 1549.
- **Note**: Upper German (Fagius) before the Interim; Lutheran after.
- **Texts by tradition**: Lutheran 3, Moderate Reformed 2.

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
1	Zuchtherrenordnung [1533]	1533	17/1, p. 429	796	Discipline / police	MR	
2	Auszug aus der Stadtordnung zum Eherecht 1544	1544	17/1, p. 435	797	Marriage	MR	
3	Ehegerichtsordnung 1566/1600	1600	17/1, p. 439	798	Consistory / synod / government	L	

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
4	Ordnung des Ehegerichts [1600]	1600	17/1, p. 451	799	Consistory / synod / government	L	
5	Agende [um 1600]	1600	17/1, p. 455	800	Agenda / liturgy	L	

1.25.5 Imperial city of Gengenbach

- **Tradition**: Moderate Reformed.
- **Note**: A short Reformation (1525-1548) under Strasbourg influence.

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
1	Mandat zur Schulmeisteranstellung [1536-1544]	1544	17/1, p. 483	804	Mandate / decree	MR	
2	Schulmeisterordnung [1536-1544]	1544	17/1, p. 484	805	School / university	MR	
3a	Schreiben der Prädikanten an den Rat, eine Kirchenordnung zu erlassen 1538	1538	17/1, p. 485	805	Church order	MR	
3b	Kirchenordnung 1538: Reformationsartikel der evangelischen Geistlichen 1538	1538	17/1, p. 488	805	Other	MR	
3c	Kirchenordnung 1538: Kirchenordnung [1538]	1538	17/1, p. 491	805	Church order	MR	
4	Vertrag zum Unterhalt des Pfarrers, seines Helfers und des Schulmeisters 1540	1540	17/1, p. 499	806	School / university	MR	
5	Gengenbacher Katechismus 1545	1545	17/1, p. 501	807	Catechism / instruction	MR	
6	Ordnung zu Eherechtsfragen [1536-1544]	1544	17/1, p. 512	808	Marriage	MR	

1.25.6 Württemberg: school orders of the Great Church Order of 1559 (supplement to vol. 16)

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
42l	Die Schulordnungen aus der württembergischen Großen Kirchenordnung von 1559: Ordnung der Lateinschulen	1559	17/1, p. 525	812	School / university	L	
42m	Die Schulordnungen aus der württembergischen Großen Kirchenordnung von 1559: Ordnung des Stuttgarter Pädagogiums	1559	17/1, p. 553	813	School / university	L	
42n	Die Schulordnungen aus der württembergischen Großen Kirchenordnung von 1559: Ordnung des Tübinger Stipendiums	1559	17/1, p. 555	813	School / university	L	

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
42o	Die Schulordnungen aus der württembergischen Großen Kirchenordnung von 1559: Ordnung für adelige Schüler und Studenten	1559	17/1, p. 580	813	Local order	L	
42p	Die Schulordnungen aus der württembergischen Großen Kirchenordnung von 1559: Ordnung der deutschen Schulen	1559	17/1, p. 583	813	School / university	L	
42q	Die Schulordnungen aus der württembergischen Großen Kirchenordnung von 1559: Ordnung für Leib- und Wundärzte	1559	17/1, p. 588	813	Local order	L	
42r	Die Schulordnungen aus der württembergischen Großen Kirchenordnung von 1559: Ordnung der Schreib- und Rechenschulen	1559	17/1, p. 591	813	School / university	L	

1.26 Volume 17/2: Baden-Württemberg III/2: Reutlingen, Ulm, Esslingen and other cities

116 texts.

1.26.1 Imperial city of Reutlingen

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
1	Täufermandat 1528	1528	17/2, p. 36	826	Discipline / police	L	
2	Kirchenordnung [um 1531]	1531	17/2, p. 38	827	Church order	L	
3	Ordnung der Schule und des Kirchengesangs 1565/66	1565	17/2, p. 47	828	Agenda / liturgy	L	
4	Zuchtordnung 1573	1573	17/2, p. 52	829	Discipline / police	L	
5	Artikel der Schulvisitation 1574	1574	17/2, p. 57	830	Visitation	L	

1.26.2 Imperial city of Ulm

- **Tradition**: Moderate Reformed; Lutheran from 1549.
- **Note**: Upper German (Bucer, Oecolampadius, Blarer: order of 1531) until the Interim; Lutheran after, on the Württemberg model.
- **Texts by tradition**: Lutheran 20, Moderate Reformed 15.

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
1	Almosenordnung 1528	1528	17/2, p. 86	833	Poor relief	MR	
2	Ulmer Katechismus des Konrad Sam 1528/1536	1536	17/2, p. 97	834	Catechism / instruction	MR	

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
3	Täufermandat 1531	1531	17/2, p. 121	835	Discipline / police	MR	
4	Ratsbeschlüsse zu Taufen und Eheeinsegnungen 1531	1531	17/2, p. 123	836	Agenda / liturgy	MR	
5	Kirchenordnung 1531	1531	17/2, p. 124	837	Church order	MR	
6	Das „Handbüchlein“ - Die Ulmer Agende 1531	1531	17/2, p. 163	838	Agenda / liturgy	MR	
7	Ehegerichtsordnung 1534	1534	17/2, p. 184	839	Consistory / synod / government	MR	
8	Mandat zum Verbot des Messbesuchs außerhalb von Ulm 1537	1537	17/2, p. 191	840	Mandate / decree	MR	
9a	Visitationsartikel o.D	n.d.	17/2, p. 192	840	Visitation	MR	early 1530s (editor), after the church order of 1531
9b	Visitationsartikel 1534	1534	17/2, p. 195	840	Visitation	MR	
9c	Visitationsartikel 1537	1537	17/2, p. 197	840	Visitation	MR	
10	Ordnung für die Superintendenten des Ulmer Landgebiets [1537?]	1537	17/2, p. 199	841	Consistory / synod / government	MR	
11	Fragenkatalog für die Synode 1539	1539	17/2, p. 200	842	Consistory / synod / government	MR	
12	Mandat zur Sonntagsheiligung 1541	1541	17/2, p. 203	843	Mandate / decree	MR	
13	Verbot von Neuaufnahmen in Klöstern 1544	1544	17/2, p. 204	844	Mandate / decree	MR	
14	Mandat zur Religionstoleranz 1554	1554	17/2, p. 205	845	Mandate / decree	L	
15	Verzeichnis der gültigen Feiertage 1554	1554	17/2, p. 206	846	Discipline / police	L	
16	Mandat zur Sonn- und Feiertagsheiligung 1554	1554	17/2, p. 207	847	Mandate / decree	L	
17	Ordnung der Pfarrkonvente 1556	1556	17/2, p. 208	848	Consistory / synod / government	L	
18	Verkündzettel zur Visitation des Ulmer Landgebiets 1557	1557	17/2, p. 217	849	Visitation	L	

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
19	Kanzelverkündung gegen Schmähreden auf Evangelium und Obrigkeit 1558	1558	17/2, p. 219	850	Other	L	
20	Zuchtordnung 1558	1558	17/2, p. 220	851	Discipline / police	L	
21	Ulmer Katechismus des Ludwig Rabus 1561	1561	17/2, p. 239	852	Catechism / instruction	L	
22	Ehegerichtsordnung 1565	1565	17/2, p. 255	853	Consistory / synod / government	L	
23	Mandat gegen Wahrsager und Segensprecher 1567	1567	17/2, p. 269	854	Mandate / decree	L	
24	Anweisungen für Amtsträger im Ulmer Landgebiet 1567	1567	17/2, p. 270	855	Mandate / decree	L	
25	Mandat zur Eheschließung unter Verwandten 1572	1572	17/2, p. 275	856	Mandate / decree	L	
26	Kanzelverkündung zur Prüfung der Brautleute 1584	1584	17/2, p. 276	857	Marriage	L	
27a	Berichte und Ratsentscheide zur Einzelbeichte 1586: Bericht der Prediger über die Beichte [1586]	1586	17/2, p. 277	858	Agenda / liturgy	L	
27b	Berichte und Ratsentscheide zur Einzelbeichte 1586: Ratsentscheid über den Bericht der Prediger 1586	1586	17/2, p. 282	858	Mandate / decree	L	
27c	Berichte und Ratsentscheide zur Einzelbeichte 1586: Bericht der Prediger über die Beichtzeiten 1586	1586	17/2, p. 283	858	Mandate / decree	L	
27d	Berichte und Ratsentscheide zur Einzelbeichte 1586: Ratsentscheid über den Bericht der Prediger 1586	1586	17/2, p. 285	858	Mandate / decree	L	
28	Resolution zu Schul- und Kirchensachen 1593	1593	17/2, p. 286	859	School / university	L	
29	Ulmer Katechismus des Johannes Veesenbeck 1598	1598	17/2, p. 295	860	Catechism / instruction	L	
30	Eheordnung 1600	1600	17/2, p. 307	861	Marriage	L	

1.26.3 Imperial city of Esslingen

- **Tradition**: Moderate Reformed; Lutheran from 1549.
- **Note**: Upper German (Blarer) until the Interim; Lutheran after.
- **Texts by tradition**: Moderate Reformed 34, Lutheran 6.

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
1	Ratsverkündung zur Anstellung eines Predigers und Wahrung des innerstädtischen Friedens in der Religionsfrage 1531	1531	17/2, p. 329	864	Appointment / oath	MR	
2	Ratsdekret zur Einführung der Reformation 1531	1531	17/2, p. 331	865	Mandate / decree	MR	
3	Verbot, in anderen Orten die Messe zu besuchen 1531	1531	17/2, p. 333	866	Mandate / decree	MR	
4	Verbot, Kleriker und Ordensgeistliche zu beleidigen 1531	1531	17/2, p. 334	867	Mandate / decree	MR	
5	Zuchtordnung 1532	1532	17/2, p. 335	868	Discipline / police	MR	
6	Neuordnung des Esslinger Pfarrsprengels [1532]	1532	17/2, p. 357	869	Other	MR	
7	Ordnung der Leibgedinge für Konventualen und Organisation der Barfüßerpfarrei [1532]	1532	17/2, p. 359	870	Consistory / synod / government	MR	
8	Ordnung für die Bezirkszuchtherren 1532	1532	17/2, p. 361	871	Discipline / police	MR	
9	Aufgaben der Bezirkszuchtherren [1532]	1532	17/2, p. 363	872	Discipline / police	MR	
10	Ratsverkündung gegen die Täufer 1532	1532	17/2, p. 364	873	Discipline / police	MR	
11	Artikel zu Gottesdienstbesuch und Abendmahlsempfang 1532	1532	17/2, p. 365	874	Agenda / liturgy	MR	
12	Instruktionen für die Verordneten im Dominikanerkloster 1532	1532	17/2, p. 370	875	Monastery / chapter	MR	
13	Mandat für die altgläubigen Geistlichen 1532	1532	17/2, p. 371	876	Mandate / decree	MR	
14	Verordnung für die Zunftherren zur Sonn- und Feiertagsheiligung 1533	1533	17/2, p. 372	877	Discipline / police	MR	
15	Prädikantenordnung [1533]	1533	17/2, p. 373	878	Other	MR	
16	Ordnung zur Zusammenziehung der verbliebenen Mönche im Barfüßerkloster [1533]	1533	17/2, p. 376	879	Monastery / chapter	MR	
17	Ordnung zum Besuch der Predigtgottesdienste 1534	1534	17/2, p. 378	880	Agenda / liturgy	MR	
18	Artikel für den deutschen Schulmeister [1534]	1534	17/2, p. 381	881	Articles / statutes	MR	
19	Ordnung für die Konventualen im Barfüßerkloster 1535	1535	17/2, p. 382	882	Consistory / synod / government	MR	

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
20	Mandat zu Eheeinsegnungen 1535	1535	17/2, p. 384	883	Mandate / decree	MR	
21a	Reformartikel und Ordnung kirchlicher Belange: Reformartikel 1536	1536	17/2, p. 385	883	Other	MR	
21b	Reformartikel und Ordnung kirchlicher Belange: Ordnung kirchlicher Belange 1536	1536	17/2, p. 386	883	Local order	MR	
22a	Mandate zu Sonntagsheiligung und Feiertagen: Gebot der Sonntagsheiligung und Ordnung der Feiertage 1537	1537	17/2, p. 389	883	Discipline / police	MR	
22b	Mandate zu Sonntagsheiligung und Feiertagen: Ordnung der Feiertage [1537]	1537	17/2, p. 390	883	Discipline / police	MR	
23	Protokoll zur Abfindung der Konventualen im Barfüßerkloster 1538	1538	17/2, p. 391	884	Consistory / synod / government	MR	
24	Artikel zum Kirchen- und Schulwesen 1538	1538	17/2, p. 392	885	Articles / statutes	MR	
25	Läuteordnung für den Predigtgottesdienst 1540	1540	17/2, p. 394	886	Agenda / liturgy	MR	
26a	Ordnung des Gebetsgottesdiensts: Ratsverkündung für den Gebetsgottesdienst 1542	1542	17/2, p. 395	886	Agenda / liturgy	MR	
26b	Ratssatzung, den Gebetsgottesdienst nicht vorzeitig zu verlassen [1543]	1543	17/2, p. 396	886	Agenda / liturgy	MR	
27	Kanzelverkündung zur Zuchtordnung und Sonntagsheiligung 1543	1543	17/2, p. 397	887	Discipline / police	MR	
28	Täufermandat 1544	1544	17/2, p. 399	888	Discipline / police	MR	
29	Kanzelverkündung: Verbot von Rosenkränzen 1544	1544	17/2, p. 400	889	Mandate / decree	MR	
30	Mandat zur Einschärfung der Zuchtordnung 1547	1547	17/2, p. 401	890	Mandate / decree	MR	
31	Mandat zur Verkündung der Brautleute in der Kirche 1547	1547	17/2, p. 402	891	Mandate / decree	MR	
32	Ordnung des Katechismusunterrichts 1551	1551	17/2, p. 403	892	Catechism / instruction	L	
33	Kanzelverkündung zur Eheschließung unter Verwandten 1554	1554	17/2, p. 404	893	Marriage	L	
34	Täufermandat für Möhringen und Vaihingen 1563	1563	17/2, p. 405	894	Discipline / police	L	
35	Mandat zur Eheeinsegnung nur mit Zustimmung des Rats 1564	1564	17/2, p. 408	895	Mandate / decree	L	

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
36	Kanzelverkündung zur Eheschließungen unter Verwandten 1594	1594	17/2, p. 409	896	Marriage	L	
37	Ordnung gegen Hurerei und Ehebruch 1602	1602	17/2, p. 410	897	Marriage	L	

1.26.4 Imperial city of Giengen an der Brenz

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
1	Eheordnung 1583	1583	17/2, p. 423	901	Marriage	L	

1.26.5 Imperial city of Biberach an der Riß

- **Tradition**: Moderate Reformed; Lutheran from 1549.
- **Note**: Upper German (Zwinglian) until the Interim; biconfessional afterwards.
- **Texts by tradition**: Moderate Reformed 3, Lutheran 3.
- **Interim**: 2 text(s) tied to the Augsburg Interim (see the last column).

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
1	Ratsbeschluss zum Verbot der Messe 1531	1531	17/2, p. 439	905	Mandate / decree	MR	
2	Zucht- und Eheordnung 1531	1531	17/2, p. 440	906	Marriage	MR	
3	Ratsmandat für die Prediger zur Gewissensfreiheit nach Annahme des Interims [1548]	1548	17/2, p. 449	907	Mandate / decree	MR	**Interim order**; council's mandate after accepting the Interim
4	Täufermandat [1549]	1549	17/2, p. 451	908	Discipline / police	L	**Under the Interim**
5	Feiertagsmandat 1554	1554	17/2, p. 452	909	Discipline / police	L	
6	Mandat Kaiser Ferdinands I. zur Biberacher Religionstoleranz 1563	1563	17/2, p. 453	910	Mandate / decree	L	

1.26.6 Imperial city of Ravensburg

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.
- **Note**: Biconfessional after the Interim.

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
1	Beschluss von Rat und Bürgerschaft zur Predigt des Evangeliums 1545	1545	17/2, p. 471	913	Mandate / decree	L	
2	Anweisung zur Abschaffung altgläubiger Zeremonien 1546	1546	17/2, p. 472	914	Agenda / liturgy	L	

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
3	Verbot, außerhalb Ravensburgs zur Messe zu gehen 1546	1546	17/2, p. 473	915	Mandate / decree	L	
4	Anweisungen für die altgläubigen Geistlichen 1546	1546	17/2, p. 474	916	Mandate / decree	L	
5	Anweisung zur Residenz der Pfründeninhaber 1546	1546	17/2, p. 475	917	Mandate / decree	L	
6	Zuchtordnung 1546	1546	17/2, p. 476	918	Discipline / police	L	
7	Vertragsauszug zur bikonfessionellen Nutzung der Karmeliterkirche 1554	1554	17/2, p. 495	919	Treaty / agreement	L	
8	Mandate zur Toleranz zwischen den Anhängern verschiedener Konfessionen 1555/85	1555	17/2, p. 496	920	Mandate / decree	L	
9	Lutherisches Abendmahlsbekenntnis 1557	1557	17/2, p. 498	921	Confession / doctrine	L	
10	Konkordie und Kirchenordnung 1578	1578	17/2, p. 500	922	Church order	L	
11	Mandat zur Toleranz unter Katholiken und Protestanten 1610	1610	17/2, p. 506	923	Mandate / decree	L	

1.26.7 Imperial city of Wimpfen

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
1	Festsetzung der gültigen Feiertage 1545	1545	17/2, p. 516	926	Discipline / police	L	
2	Mandat Kaiser Maximilians II. zur Anstellung evangelischer Prediger 1566	1566	17/2, p. 517	927	Mandate / decree	L	
3	Regelung der Predigtzeiten und Festtage beider Konfessionen 1568	1568	17/2, p. 519	928	Discipline / police	L	
4	Mandat Kaiser Maximilians II. zur Ausweisung der Evangelischen aus der Pfarrkirche 1570	1570	17/2, p. 523	929	Mandate / decree	L	
5	Vertrag zur Nutzung der Klosterkirche durch die evangeiische Gemeinde [1570]	1570	17/2, p. 527	930	Monastery / chapter	L	
6	Vergleich zur Nutzung der Klosterkirche von Anhängern beider Konfessionen 1571	1571	17/2, p. 529	930	Monastery / chapter	L	
7	Eid und Pflichten der Geistlichen [nach 1577]	1577	17/2, p. 530	930	Appointment / oath	L	
8	Regelung der Gottesdienstzeiten in der Pfarrkirche 1589	1589	17/2, p. 531	930	Agenda / liturgy	L	

1.26.8 Imperial city of Leutkirch

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
1	Vertrag zu den Rechten der katholischen und evangelischen Gemeinde 1562	1562	17/2, p. 540	934	Treaty / agreement	L	
2	Ratsentscheid für den Schulmeister 1569	1569	17/2, p. 543	935	School / university	L	
3	Dekret für die Prädikanten zum Kalenderstreit 1603	1603	17/2, p. 544	936	Mandate / decree	L	
4	Dekret für die Bürgerschaft zum Kalenderstreit 1603	1603	17/2, p. 546	937	Mandate / decree	L	
5	Vertragsauszug zum Glockenläuten bei Begräbnissen 1605	1605	17/2, p. 548	938	Agenda / liturgy	L	

1.26.9 Imperial city of Bopfingen

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
1	Bucherwerb für die Pfarrkirche 1546	1546	17/2, p. 555	941	Other	L	
2	Ratsbeschlüsse für die evangelischen Geistlichen 1563/1567	1567	17/2, p. 556	942	Other	L	
3	Eingabe der Prediger und Ratsentscheidungen zur Ordnung des kirchlichen Lebens 1607	1607	17/2, p. 557	943	Other	L	

1.26.10 Imperial city of Aalen

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
1	Ratsverkündung und Abstimmung zur Annahme der Confessio Augustana 1575	1575	17/2, p. 566	948	Confession / doctrine	L	
2	Vertrag zur Besoldung der evangelischen Geistlichen 1576	1576	17/2, p. 569	949	Treaty / agreement	L	

1.27 Volume 18: Rhineland-Palatinate I: Pfalz-Zweibrücken, Veldenz, Sponheim

62 texts.

1.27.1 Duchy of Pfalz-Zweibrücken

- **Tradition**: Lutheran; Reformed from 1588.
- **Note**: Lutheran until Johann I introduced the Reformed catechism in 1588.
- **Texts by tradition**: Lutheran 29, Reformed 13.

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
1	12 Artikel „Form und Maß“ 1533	1533	18, p. 49	963	Other	L	
2	Ordnung des Katechismuswesens 1538	1538	18, p. 54	964	Catechism / instruction	L	
3	Kirchenordnung „Form und Ordnung“ 1539	1539	18, p. 55	965	Church order	L	
4	Kirchenzuchtordnung 1539	1539	18, p. 67	966	Discipline / police	L	
5	Kirchenordnung 1557	1557	18, p. 71	967	Church order	L	
6	Mandat gegen Gotteslästerung 1557	1557	18, p. 260	968	Mandate / decree	L	
7	Mandat zur Kirchenzensur 1558	1558	18, p. 264	969	Mandate / decree	L	
8	Visitationsordnungen 1558	1558	18, p. 265	970	Visitation	L	
9	Generalartikel 1560	1560	18, p. 277	971	Visitation	L	
10	Mandat zur Abschaffung der Volksbräuche 1560	1560	18, p. 296	972	Mandate / decree	L	
11	Feiertagsordnung 1561	1561	18, p. 297	973	Discipline / police	L	
12	Superintendentenordnung 1562	1562	18, p. 299	974	Consistory / synod / government	L	
13	Mandat zur Kirchenrechnung 1562	1562	18, p. 302	975	Mandate / decree	L	
14	Mandat zur Druckzensur 1562	1562	18, p. 303	976	Mandate / decree	L	
15	Ehemandate 1561/1563	1563	18, p. 304	977	Marriage	L	
16	Sonntagsmandat 1563	1563	18, p. 308	978	Discipline / police	L	
17	Fürbittenmandate 1563/1566	1566	18, p. 309	979	Mandate / decree	L	
18	Begräbnismandat 1564	1564	18, p. 314	980	Agenda / liturgy	L	
19	Mandat gegen die Calvinisten 1564	1564	18, p. 315	981	Mandate / decree	L	
20	Bekenntnisverpflichtung der Kirchendiener 1564	1564	18, p. 319	982	Confession / doctrine	L	
21	Ordnung für den Generalsuperintendenten 1564	1564	18, p. 334	983	Consistory / synod / government	L	

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
22	Almosenordnung 1565	1565	18, p. 336	984	Poor relief	L	
23	Ordnung der Kirchengesänge 1565	1565	18, p. 337	985	Church order	L	
24	Pfarrhausmandat 1566	1566	18, p. 342	986	Mandate / decree	L	
25	Ordinationszeugnis 1567	1567	18, p. 343	987	Agenda / liturgy	L	
26	Mandat zur Einhaltung der Kirchenordnung 1570	1570	18, p. 345	988	Church order	L	
27	Visitationsordnung 1575	1575	18, p. 349	989	Visitation	L	
28	Sonntagsmandate 1577/1592	1592	18, p. 364	990	Discipline / police	R	
29	Visitationsformular 1579	1579	18, p. 367	991	Visitation	L	
30	Dienstanweisung für die Pfarrer des Amtes Lichtenberg 1579	1579	18, p. 377	992	Mandate / decree	L	
31	Verordnungen zur Einführung des neuen Katechismus 1588	1588	18, p. 381	993	Catechism / instruction	R	
32	Katechismus 1588	1588	18, p. 384	994	Catechism / instruction	R	
33	Synodalordnung 1592	1592	18, p. 401	995	Consistory / synod / government	R	
34	Dorfschulmandat 1592	1592	18, p. 406	996	School / university	R	
35	Festmandat 1594	1594	18, p. 408	997	Mandate / decree	R	
36	Mandat zur Ablieferung der Vasa sacra 1595	1595	18, p. 410	998	Mandate / decree	R	
37	Visitationsordnung 1597	1597	18, p. 411	999	Visitation	R	
38	Eheordnung 1605	1605	18, p. 414	1000	Marriage	R	
39	Ehebruchmandat 1605	1605	18, p. 432	1001	Marriage	R	
40	Mandat betr. Korrekturen zur Kirchenordnung 1605	1605	18, p. 439	1002	Church order	R	
42	Pfarrkonventsordnung 1616	1616	18, p. 441	1003	Consistory / synod / government	R	

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
43	Reformationsjubiläum 1617	1617	18, p. 443	1004	Other	R	

1.27.2 County of Pfalz-Veldenz with Lützelstein and Guttenberg

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
1	Visitationsordnung 1558	1558	18, p. 452	1007	Visitation	L	
5	Feiertagsordnung 1570	1570	18, p. 457	1008	Discipline / police	L	
6	Begräbnisordnung 1571	1571	18, p. 458	1009	Agenda / liturgy	L	
7	Generalartikel 1571	1571	18, p. 459	1010	Visitation	L	
11	Kirchenordnung Lützelstein 1605	1605	18, p. 459	1010	Church order	L	
8	Kirchenordnung 1574	1574	18, p. 462	1011	Church order	L	

1.27.3 Counties of Sponheim

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
1	Reformation in der Vorderen Grafschaft Sponheim	n.d.	18, p. 628	1015	Church order	L	
2	Visitationsrelation 1560	1560	18, p. 635	1016	Visitation	L	
4	Abschaffung katholischer Bräuche 1575	1575	18, p. 642	1017	Mandate / decree	L	
5	Gemeine Punkte [nach 1577]	1577	18, p. 643	1018	Other	L	
7	Kompetenzordnung [nach 1579]	1579	18, p. 646	1019	Other	L	
8	Kirchen- und Zensurordnung 1590/91	1590	18, p. 648	1020	Other	L	
9	Superintendentenordnung 1592	1592	18, p. 660	1021	Consistory / synod / government	L	
10	Generalartikel 1599	1599	18, p. 662	1021	Visitation	L	
11	Kirchen- und Zensurordnung 1607	1607	18, p. 666	1021	Other	L	
12	Generalartikel 1608	1608	18, p. 671	1021	Visitation	L	
13	Mandat zum Reformationsjubiläum 1617	1617	18, p. 684	1021	Mandate / decree	L	

1.27.4 Lordship of Sickingen

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
1	Bekenntnis der Kirchendiener [1564]	1564	18, p. 689	1024	Confession / doctrine	L	
2	Kirchenordnung Ebernburg 1572	1572	18, p. 698	1025	Church order	L	

1.27.5 County of Manderscheid-Schleiden

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
	Befehl zur Austeilung des Abendmahls unter beiderlei Gestalt 1566	1566	18, p. 706	1028	Mandate / decree	L	

1.28 Volume 19/1: Rhineland-Palatinate II/1: Landau, Speyer, Worms, Leiningen, Sayn, Wied

61 texts.

1.28.1 Imperial city of Landau

- **Tradition**: Moderate Reformed; Lutheran from 1555.
- **Note**: Johannes Bader's early Reformation; Strasbourg Lutheranism after 1555.
- **Texts by tradition**: Lutheran 7, Moderate Reformed 5.

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
1	Katechismus 1526	1526	19/1, p. 34	1039	Catechism / instruction	MR	
2	Katechismus 1544	1544	19/1, p. 45	1040	Catechism / instruction	MR	
3	Ratsprotokoll zu Fragen der Kirchenordnung 1554	1554	19/1, p. 57	1041	Church order	MR	
4	Ratsprotokoll zur Predigt 1554	1554	19/1, p. 58	1042	Mandate / decree	MR	
5	Ratsprotokoll zum Almosen 1554	1554	19/1, p. 59	1043	Poor relief	MR	
6	Feiertagsordnung 1562	1562	19/1, p. 60	1044	Discipline / police	L	
7	Mandat zum Gottesdienstbesuch und zur Polizeiordnung 1571	1571	19/1, p. 62	1045	Mandate / decree	L	
8	Verhandlungen gegen Calvinisten 1582	1582	19/1, p. 65	1046	Treaty / agreement	L	
9	Ratsprotokoll wegen des Katechismus 1595	1595	19/1, p. 66	1047	Catechism / instruction	L	

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
10	Mandat gegen das Schmähen auf der Kanzel 1608	1608	19/1, p. 67	1048	Mandate / decree	L	
11	Ratsprotokoll wegen des Kirchgangs des Magistrats 1610	1610	19/1, p. 70	1049	Discipline / police	L	
12	Einführung der Straßburger Kirchenzensur 1611	1611	19/1, p. 71	1050	Other	L	

1.28.2 Imperial city of Speyer

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
1	Vertrag zwischen Stadt und Klerus 1525	1525	19/1, p. 83	1054	Treaty / agreement	L	
2	Bedenken der Predigt halben 1538	1538	19/1, p. 87	1055	Mandate / decree	L	
3	Anstellung evangelischer Prediger 1545	1545	19/1, p. 90	1056	Appointment / oath	L	
4	Kirchenordnung 1557	1557	19/1, p. 91	1057	Church order	L	
5	Kirchenordnung 1569	1569	19/1, p. 94	1058	Church order	L	
6	Vergleich zwischen Stadt und Augustinerorden 1570	1570	19/1, p. 106	1059	Treaty / agreement	L	
7	Ordnung des Katechismuswesens 1597	1597	19/1, p. 107	1060	Catechism / instruction	L	
8	Mandat zum Gottesdienst 1605	1605	19/1, p. 110	1061	Mandate / decree	L	
9	Verbot von Begräbnissen in der Kirche 1608	1608	19/1, p. 112	1062	Mandate / decree	L	
10	Mandat zur Errichtung eines Konsistoriums und zur Amtsführung der Pfarrer 1612	1612	19/1, p. 113	1063	Mandate / decree	L	

1.28.3 Imperial city of Worms

- **Tradition**: Moderate Reformed; Lutheran from 1552.
- **Note**: Upper German beginnings; Lutheran consolidation after 1552.
- **Texts by tradition**: Moderate Reformed 3, Lutheran 1.

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
1	Deutsche Messe 1524	1524	19/1, p. 124	1066	Agenda / liturgy	MR	

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
2	Vertrag zwischen Stadt und Klerus 1525	1525	19/1, p. 130	1067	Treaty / agreement	MR	
3	Katechismus 1543	1543	19/1, p. 134	1068	Catechism / instruction	MR	
4	Agendbüchlein 1560	1560	19/1, p. 160	1069	Agenda / liturgy	L	

1.28.4 Counties of Leiningen

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
1	Kirchenordnungsmandat 1566	1566	19/1, p. 222	1072	Church order	L	
2	Kirchenzuchtordnung 1566	1566	19/1, p. 225	1073	Discipline / police	L	
3	Kirchenordnung 1566	1566	19/1, p. 230	1074	Church order	L	
4	Kirchenordnungsmandat 1581	1581	19/1, p. 275	1075	Church order	L	
5	Kirchenordnungsmandat 1584	1584	19/1, p. 277	1076	Church order	L	
6	Mandat zum Gottesdienstbesuch 1587	1587	19/1, p. 280	1077	Mandate / decree	L	
7	Kirchenordnungsmandat [nach 1593]	1593	19/1, p. 281	1078	Church order	L	
8	Visitationsordnung 1597	1597	19/1, p. 284	1079	Visitation	L	
9	Visitations- und Täuferordnung 1609	1609	19/1, p. 298	1080	Visitation	L	
10	Mandat zum Gottesdienstbesuch 1610	1610	19/1, p. 320	1081	Mandate / decree	L	
11	Mandat zum Reformationsjubiläum 1617	1617	19/1, p. 321	1082	Mandate / decree	L	

1.28.5 County of Sayn

- **Tradition**: Lutheran; Reformed from 1605.
- **Note**: Lutheran until the Reformed confession was introduced in 1605.
- **Texts by tradition**: Lutheran 13, Reformed 3.

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
1	Anordnung evangelischer Predigt 1560	1560	19/1, p. 333	1085	Mandate / decree	L	
2	Protokoll des Konsistoriums 1573	1573	19/1, p. 334	1086	Consistory / synod / government	L	
3	Mandat zur Anordnung des Pfarrerexamens 1573	1573	19/1, p. 336	1087	Mandate / decree	L	
4	Kirchenordnung 1574	1574	19/1, p. 337	1088	Church order	L	
5	Protokoll des Konsistoriums 1575	1575	19/1, p. 353	1089	Consistory / synod / government	L	
6	Mandat zum Besuch der Gottesdienste 1581	1581	19/1, p. 357	1090	Mandate / decree	L	
7	Mandat zur Einziehung der Kirchenzinsen 1581	1581	19/1, p. 359	1090	Mandate / decree	L	
8	Sendschöffenordnung 1581	1581	19/1, p. 361	1090	Other	L	
9	Kirchenzuchtordnung 1582	1582	19/1, p. 362	1090	Discipline / police	L	
10	Mandat zur Aufsicht über die kirchlichen Gebäude 1582	1582	19/1, p. 376	1090	Mandate / decree	L	
11	Protokoll des Konsistoriums 1582	1582	19/1, p. 377	1090	Consistory / synod / government	L	
12	Almosenordnung 1587	1587	19/1, p. 379	1090	Poor relief	L	
13	Kirchenordnung 1590	1590	19/1, p. 385	1090	Church order	L	
14	Sendschöffenordnung 1606	1606	19/1, p. 449	1090	Other	R	
15	Visitationsartikel 1609	1609	19/1, p. 453	1090	Visitation	R	
16	Kirchenordnungsmandat 1619	1619	19/1, p. 454	1090	Church order	R	

1.28.6 County of Wied

- **Tradition**: Reformed.
- **Note**: The synod of 1564 already prescribes the Heidelberg Catechism.

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
1	Synodalbeschlüsse 1564	1564	19/1, p. 465	1094	Consistory / synod / government	R	

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
2	Kirchenzuchtordnung 1590	1590	19/1, p. 469	1095	Discipline / police	R	
3	Synodalbeschluss zur Pfarrwitwenversorgung [1592]	1592	19/1, p. 473	1096	Consistory / synod / government	R	
4	Synodalbeschlüsse 1593	1593	19/1, p. 474	1097	Consistory / synod / government	R	
5	Kirchenzuchtordnung 1600	1600	19/1, p. 476	1098	Discipline / police	R	
6	Synodalbeschlüsse 1602 / 1609	1609	19/1, p. 490	1099	Consistory / synod / government	R	
7	Kirchen- und Polizeiordnung 1616	1616	19/1, p. 492	1100	Discipline / police	R	
8	Visitationsartikel 1619	1619	19/1, p. 509	1101	Visitation	R	

1.29 Volume 19/2: Rhineland-Palatinate II/2: Wild- and Rhinegraviate, Simmern; supplements

98 texts.

1.29.1 Wild- and Rhinegraviate

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
1	Kirchenzuchtordnung 1563	1563	19/2, p. 532	1106	Discipline / police	L	
2	Reformationsmandat Vinstingen 1565	1565	19/2, p. 537	1107	Mandate / decree	L	
3	Synodalprotokoll 1568	1568	19/2, p. 539	1108	Consistory / synod / government	L	
4	Superintendentenordnungen 1576/1584	1584	19/2, p. 542	1109	Consistory / synod / government	L	
5	Erster Vertrag über die Konfession der Herrschaft Vinstingen 1584	1584	19/2, p. 549	1110	Treaty / agreement	L	
7	Visitationsmandat 1584	1584	19/2, p. 552	1111	Visitation	L	
8	Entlassungszeugnis 1586	1586	19/2, p. 553	1112	Other	L	
9	Zweiter Vertrag über die Konfession der Herrschaft Vinstingen 1596	1596	19/2, p. 554	1113	Treaty / agreement	L	
10	Pestordnung 1597	1597	19/2, p. 556	1114	Discipline / police	L	

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
11	Visitationsordnung [ca. 1597]	1597	19/2, p. 558	1115	Visitation	L	
12	Pfarrkonventsordnung [ca. 1597]	1597	19/2, p. 560	1116	Consistory / synod / government	L	
13	Superintendentenordnung [1597]	1597	19/2, p. 563	1117	Consistory / synod / government	L	
14	Ordinationsordnung [1597]	1597	19/2, p. 568	1118	Agenda / liturgy	L	
15	Patenordnung [1597]	1597	19/2, p. 573	1118	Other	L	
16	Ratifikationsordnung [1597]	1597	19/2, p. 579	1118	Other	L	
17	Kirchenzuchtordnung [1597]	1597	19/2, p. 581	1118	Discipline / police	L	
18	Dienstanweisung für Pfarrer 1599	1599	19/2, p. 583	1118	Mandate / decree	L	
19	Zensorenordnung [um 1600]	1600	19/2, p. 585	1119	Other	L	
20	Kirchmeistereid [um 1600]	1600	19/2, p. 587	1120	Other	L	
21	Kirchenordnung [nach 1603]	1603	19/2, p. 588	1121	Church order	L	
22	Pestordnung 1612	1612	19/2, p. 645	1122	Discipline / police	L	
22	Dritter Vertrag über die Konfession der Herrschaft Vinstingen 1618	1618	19/2, p. 648	1122	Treaty / agreement	L	

1.29.2 Principality of Pfalz-Simmern

- **Tradition**: Lutheran; Reformed from 1598. Duke Reichard held to the Augsburg Confession until his death on 14 January 1598, when the principality fell to the Electoral Palatinate. The two mandates of 1598 were issued from Heidelberg under Elector Frederick IV, and the first ordered the churches cleared "im reformierten Sinne" (in the Reformed sense; Sehling 19/2, p. 656).

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
1	Klosterordnung 1560	1560	19/2, p. 657	1125	Monastery / chapter	L	
2	Mandat zur Abschaffung der Bilder und Altäre 1598	1598	19/2, p. 661	1126	Mandate / decree	R	
3	Mandat zur geistlichen Güterverwaltung 1598	1598	19/2, p. 662	1127	Mandate / decree	R	

1.29.3 County of Pfalz-Veldenz (supplement to vol. 18)

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
7	Generalartikel 1571	1571	19/2, p. 666	1130	Visitation	L	

1.29.4 Electoral Palatinate (supplement to vol. 14)

- **Tradition**: Lutheran; Reformed from 1561; Lutheran from 1577, save in Johann Casimir's Reformed Pfalz-Lautern (nos. 8, 9 and 11); Reformed from 1583.
- **Texts by tradition**: Reformed 65, Lutheran 7.

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
1	Verbot der katholischen Messe 1546	1546	19/2, p. 715	1134	Mandate / decree	L	
2	Kirchenregimentsordnung 1577	1577	19/2, p. 716	1135	Consistory / synod / government	L	
3	Visitationsbedenken [März 1578]	1578	19/2, p. 720	1136	Visitation	L	
4	Superintendentenordnung 1580	1580	19/2, p. 723	1137	Consistory / synod / government	L	
5	Kirchenbußordnung [1579]	1579	19/2, p. 734	1138	Agenda / liturgy	L	
6	Kirchenbußordnung 1580	1580	19/2, p. 739	1139	Agenda / liturgy	L	
7	Verordnung von Senioren [1581]	1581	19/2, p. 748	1140	Mandate / decree	L	
8	Eid der Kirchenschaffner Mai 1577	1577	19/2, p. 749	1141	Appointment / oath	R	Johann Casimir in Pfalz-Lautern; sworn also to Ludwig VI
9	Stiftung der Neustädter Hochschule 1578	1578	19/2, p. 750	1142	School / university	R	Johann Casimir in Pfalz-Lautern
11	Mandat zu den Bettagen 1580	1580	19/2, p. 754	1143	Mandate / decree	R	Johann Casimir in Pfalz-Lautern; no. 10 in the editor's introduction
11	Huldigung der Kirchendiener 1585	1585	19/2, p. 756	1143	Consistory / synod / government	R	
12	Mandat zur Einhaltung der Kirchenordnung 1587	1587	19/2, p. 757	1144	Church order	R	
13	Mandat zur Einhaltung der Polizeiordnung 1588	1588	19/2, p. 759	1145	Mandate / decree	R	
14	Ordnung des Waisenhauses zu Handschuhsheim 1588	1588	19/2, p. 761	1146	Poor relief	R	

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
15	Mandat zur Aufsicht der Amtleute über die Kirchendiener 1589	1589	19/2, p. 769	1147	Mandate / decree	R	
16	Mandat zur Aufsicht der Inspektoren über die Kirchendiener 1589	1589	19/2, p. 770	1148	Mandate / decree	R	
17	Mandat zu den Bettagen 1590	1590	19/2, p. 771	1149	Mandate / decree	R	
18	Ordnung des Sondersiechenhauses in Neuenheim 1591	1591	19/2, p. 772	1150	Poor relief	R	
19	Mandat zu den Bettagen 1591	1591	19/2, p. 777	1151	Mandate / decree	R	
20	Mandat zur Polizeiordnung 1591	1591	19/2, p. 780	1152	Mandate / decree	R	
21	Mandat zur Polizeiordnung 1592	1592	19/2, p. 785	1153	Mandate / decree	R	
22	Ordnung der Senioren 1592	1592	19/2, p. 787	1154	Local order	R	
23	Einführung der Senioren 1592	1592	19/2, p. 789	1155	Other	R	
24	Ordnung der Ordination [1592]	1592	19/2, p. 791	1156	Agenda / liturgy	R	
25	Ordnung der Einführung der Kirchendiener [1592]	1592	19/2, p. 793	1157	Agenda / liturgy	R	
26	Mandat über Druckzensur 1593	1593	19/2, p. 795	1158	Mandate / decree	R	
27	Ankündigung der Visitation 1593	1593	19/2, p. 797	1159	Visitation	R	
28	Muster der Institution [1593]	1593	19/2, p. 804	1160	Agenda / liturgy	R	
29	Visitationsabschied 1593	1593	19/2, p. 812	1161	Visitation	R	
30	Generalvisitationsinstruktion 1594	1594	19/2, p. 822	1162	Visitation	R	
31	Spitalordnung zu Heidelberg 1594	1594	19/2, p. 825	1163	Poor relief	R	
32	Patent auf die Generalvisitation 1594	1594	19/2, p. 840	1164	Mandate / decree	R	
33	Visitationsbericht [1594]	1594	19/2, p. 842	1165	Visitation	R	
34	Mandat zur Institution 1594	1594	19/2, p. 854	1166	Mandate / decree	R	
35	Mandat zur Institution und Sonntagsheiligung 1595	1595	19/2, p. 855	1167	Mandate / decree	R	

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
36	Mandat zur Institution [1595]	1595	19/2, p. 865	1168	Mandate / decree	R	
37	Mandat zur Institution und Polizeiordnung 1595	1595	19/2, p. 869	1169	Mandate / decree	R	
38	Mandat zu Leben, Lehre und Wandel der Kirchendiener	1596	19/2, p. 872	1170	Mandate / decree	R	dated 15 April 1596 in the text
39	Predigtmandat 1596	1596	19/2, p. 873	1171	Mandate / decree	R	
40	Mandat zur Amtsführung der Kirchendiener 1597	1597	19/2, p. 875	1172	Mandate / decree	R	
41	Visitationsinstruktion für die Nebenvisitatoren 1597	1597	19/2, p. 876	1173	Visitation	R	
42	Mandat zur Druckzensur 1598	1598	19/2, p. 889	1174	Mandate / decree	R	
43	Mandat zum Katechismusunterricht u.a. 1599	1599	19/2, p. 890	1175	Mandate / decree	R	
44	Mandat zum Katechimusunterricht 1599	1599	19/2, p. 892	1176	Mandate / decree	R	
45	Spitalordnung zu Branchweiler 1599	1599	19/2, p. 893	1177	Poor relief	R	
46	Spitalordnung zu Germersheim [ca. 1599]	1599	19/2, p. 902	1178	Poor relief	R	
47	Mandat zur Institution 1599	1599	19/2, p. 910	1179	Mandate / decree	R	
48	Mandat zu Almosen und Fürbitte 1599	1599	19/2, p. 912	1180	Mandate / decree	R	
49	Mandat zur Almosenordnung 1600	1600	19/2, p. 913	1181	Mandate / decree	R	
50	Punkte zur Almosenordnung 1600	1600	19/2, p. 914	1182	Poor relief	R	
51	Heidelberger Punkte zur Almosenordnung 1600	1600	19/2, p. 917	1183	Poor relief	R	
52	Mandat zu Predigt, Pfarrbesoldung, Schutz der Gottesdienste und Almosenordnung 1600	1600	19/2, p. 920	1184	Mandate / decree	R	
53	Ordnung der Classicalconvente [nach 1598 - vor 1607]	1607	19/2, p. 922	1185	Consistory / synod / government	R	
54	Mandat zur Almosenordnung 1601	1601	19/2, p. 933	1186	Mandate / decree	R	
55	Mandat zum Pfarrstellenwechsel 1601	1601	19/2, p. 934	1187	Mandate / decree	R	

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
56	Mandat zur Almosenordnung 1601	1601	19/2, p. 938	1188	Mandate / decree	R	
57	Mandat zur Institution 1602	1602	19/2, p. 939	1189	Mandate / decree	R	
58	Mandat zur Abschaffung des Bettels 1603	1603	19/2, p. 941	1190	Mandate / decree	R	
59	Mandat zur Anstellung von Schul- und Kirchendienern 1603	1603	19/2, p. 944	1191	Mandate / decree	R	
60	Ergänzung der Polizeiordnung 1604	1604	19/2, p. 945	1192	Discipline / police	R	
61	Mandat zur Polizeiordnung 1604	1604	19/2, p. 954	1193	Mandate / decree	R	
62	Mandat zur Aufsicht über die Kirchendiener und die Institution 1604	1604	19/2, p. 955	1194	Mandate / decree	R	
63	Mandat zu den Konventen, der Predigtaufsicht und den Diakonen 1607	1607	19/2, p. 956	1195	Mandate / decree	R	
64	Mandat zu den Konventen 1608	1608	19/2, p. 958	1196	Mandate / decree	R	
65	Mandat zur Institution 1608	1608	19/2, p. 959	1197	Mandate / decree	R	
66	Toleranzmandat für katholische Untertanen 1608	1608	19/2, p. 960	1198	Mandate / decree	R	
67	Mandat zur Visitation 1608	1608	19/2, p. 961	1199	Mandate / decree	R	
68	Mandat zur Institution 1608	1608	19/2, p. 963	1200	Mandate / decree	R	
69	Mandat zur Institution 1608	1608	19/2, p. 964	1201	Mandate / decree	R	
70	Mandat zu den Konventen Dezember 1609	1609	19/2, p. 965	1202	Mandate / decree	R	
71	Mandat zu den Konventen 1610	1610	19/2, p. 966	1203	Mandate / decree	R	
72	Mandat zu den Bußtagen 1610	1610	19/2, p. 968	1204	Mandate / decree	R	

1.30 Volume 20/1: Alsace I: Strasbourg

79 texts.

1.30.1 Imperial city of Strasbourg

- **Tradition**: Moderate Reformed; Lutheran from 1549.

- **Note**: Bucer's church (Upper German, Moderate Reformed) until the Interim; Lutheran orthodoxy under Marbach afterwards (order of 1598).
- **Texts by tradition**: Moderate Reformed 46, Lutheran 33.
- **Interim**: 5 text(s) tied to the Augsburg Interim (see the last column).

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
1a	Armenordnung, längere Fassung 4. August 1523	1523	20/1, p. 107	1276	Poor relief	MR	
1b	Armenordnung, kürzere Fassung [1. Oktober] 1523	1523	20/1, p. 115	1277	Poor relief	MR	
2	Mandat zur Predigt des Evangeliums 1. Dezember 1523	1523	20/1, p. 118	1278	Mandate / decree	MR	
3a	Handschriftliche Agende mit der Deutschen Messe von Theobald Schwarz und Formularen für die Taufe und die Trauung 1524	1524	20/1, p. 120	1279	Agenda / liturgy	MR	
3b	Die frühen Agenden: Teutsche Mess und Tauf 1524	1524	20/1, p. 130	1279	Agenda / liturgy	MR	
3c	Die frühen Agenden: Ordenung und inhalt Teutscher Mess 1524	1524	20/1, p. 135	1279	Agenda / liturgy	MR	
3d	Teutsch Kirchenampt mit lobgsengen und götlichen psalmen [1524/1525]	1525	20/1, p. 136	1279	Agenda / liturgy	MR	
3e	Die frühen Agenden: Ordnung des Herren Nachtmal 1525	1525	20/1, p. 142	1279	Agenda / liturgy	MR	
3f	Die frühen Agenden: Straßburger kirchen ampt Mai 1525	1525	20/1, p. 151	1279	Agenda / liturgy	MR	
3g	Die frühen Agenden: Psalmen gebett und kirchen übung 1526	1526	20/1, p. 163	1280	Agenda / liturgy	MR	
4	Verbot der konkubinarischen Verbindungen 15. März 1525	1525	20/1, p. 165	1281	Mandate / decree	MR	
5	Mandat über Bilder und Altäre 18. März 1525	1525	20/1, p. 166	1282	Mandate / decree	MR	
6	Mandat gegen die Täufer 27. Juli 1527	1527	20/1, p. 167	1283	Mandate / decree	MR	
7	Verbot der Bestattungen in Kirchen und auf Kirchhöfen 8. August 1527	1527	20/1, p. 169	1284	Mandate / decree	MR	
8	Der erste Straßburger Katechismus: Wolfgang Capitos „Kinder bericht“ 1527	1527	20/1, p. 170	1285	Catechism / instruction	MR	
9a	Vortrag des Magistrats wegen der Abschaffung der Messe [9. Januar 1529]	1529	20/1, p. 202	1286	Agenda / liturgy	MR	
9b	Beschluß über die Abschaffung der Messe 20. Februar 1529	1529	20/1, p. 207	1287	Agenda / liturgy	MR	
10	Zuchtordnung „Constitution und Satzung“ 25. August 1529	1529	20/1, p. 208	1288	Discipline / police	MR	

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
11	Eheordnung [19. Februar 1530]	1530	20/1, p. 218	1289	Marriage	MR	
12	Armenordnung 8. März 1531	1531	20/1, p. 222	1290	Poor relief	MR	
13	Verbot, an anderen Orten die Messe zu hören 3. April 1531	1531	20/1, p. 224	1291	Mandate / decree	MR	
14	Ordnung der Kirchenpfleger 30. Oktober 1531	1531	20/1, p. 225	1292	Church order	MR	
15	Mandat zum Besuch der Gottesdienste durch die Jugend und das Gesinde [22. April] 1532	1532	20/1, p. 227	1293	Mandate / decree	MR	
16	Anordnung eines Bettags wegen der Bedrohung durch die Osmanen 24. August 1532	1532	20/1, p. 228	1294	Agenda / liturgy	MR	
17	Kirchenordnung [24. Juni] 1534	1534	20/1, p. 230	1295	Church order	MR	
18	Mandat zur Sonntagsheiligung 28. Dezember 1534	1534	20/1, p. 246	1296	Mandate / decree	MR	
19a	Disziplinarordnung 7. Februar 1535	1535	20/1, p. 248	1297	Other	MR	
19b	Anweisung zur Taufe der Kinder 8. und 9. Februar 1535	1535	20/1, p. 254	1298	Agenda / liturgy	MR	
20	Statuten des Predigerkollegs [Vor 29. März 1535]	1535	20/1, p. 255	1299	Discipline / police	MR	
21	Mandat zur Bekämpfung der Irrlehren und zur Stärkung der Kirchenzucht in den Gemeinden auf dem Land 28. April 1535	1535	20/1, p. 258	1300	Mandate / decree	MR	
22	Hochzeitsmandat 12. Februar 1537	1537	20/1, p. 261	1301	Marriage	MR	
23	Agende 1537 / 1541	1541	20/1, p. 262	1302	Agenda / liturgy	MR	
24a	Mandat gegen die Täufer 23. März 1538	1538	20/1, p. 283	1303	Mandate / decree	MR	
24b	Täuferartikel 23. März 1538	1538	20/1, p. 286	1304	Discipline / police	MR	
25	Mandat zur Vorladung vor die Kirchenpfleger 29. Januar 1539	1539	20/1, p. 288	1305	Mandate / decree	MR	
26a	Munizipalstatut, lateinische Fassung [Vor 9. September 1539]	1539	20/1, p. 290	1306	Other	MR	
26b	Munizipalstatut, deutsche Fassung 9. September 1539	1539	20/1, p. 296	1307	Other	MR	

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
27a	Examensordnung, lateinische Fassung [Nach 9. September 1539]	1539	20/1, p. 300	1308	Other	MR	
27b	Examensordnung, deutsche Fassung 1540	1540	20/1, p. 316	1309	Other	MR	
28	Bettagsmandat 24. September 1541	1541	20/1, p. 324	1310	Agenda / liturgy	MR	
29	Gottesdienstordnung [Nach 18. November] 1542	1542	20/1, p. 325	1311	Agenda / liturgy	MR	
30	Synodaldekrete [11. August 1544]	1544	20/1, p. 332	1312	Consistory / synod / government	MR	
31	Weisung des Magistrats an den Kirchenkonvent, zu Buße und Beständigkeit im Glauben aufzurufen 17. Juni 1546	1546	20/1, p. 344	1313	Consistory / synod / government	MR	
32	Bettagsmandat für die Pfarreien auf dem Land [Nach 21. Juli 1546]	1546	20/1, p. 345	1314	Agenda / liturgy	MR	
33	Mandat zur Kirchenzucht 29. Januar 1548	1548	20/1, p. 347	1315	Mandate / decree	MR	
34	Übereinkunft der Geistlichen zu Lehre, Zensur und Gottesdienstgestaltung [Nach 2. Juli] 1548	1548	20/1, p. 352	1316	Agenda / liturgy	MR	**On the Interim**
35	Agende für die Taufe und Trauung 27. Juni 1549	1549	20/1, p. 357	1317	Agenda / liturgy	L	**Under the Interim**
36	Examensordnung 1549	1549	20/1, p. 364	1318	Other	L	**Under the Interim**
37a	Schiedsvertrag zwischen dem Bischof von Straßburg und dem Magistrat der Stadt über die Durchführung des Interims 23. November 1549	1549	20/1, p. 368	1319	Treaty / agreement	L	**Interim settlement**; agreement with the bishop over the Interim
37b	Mandat zum Schutz des katholischen Gottesdienstes [4. Februar 1550]	1550	20/1, p. 372	1320	Mandate / decree	L	**Under the Interim**
38	Kirchenordnung von Johannes Marbach 21. Juli 1553 / [Zwischen 21. Juli und 26. August 1557]	1557	20/1, p. 373	1321	Church order	L	
39	Stellungnahme der Straßburger Geistlichen zum Entwurf der Kirchenordnung von Johannes Marbach 26. August 1557	1557	20/1, p. 446	1322	Church order	L	
40	Mandat zu den noch bestehenden Frauenklöstern 18. November 1555	1555	20/1, p. 453	1323	Mandate / decree	L	
41	Entscheidung des Magistrats über den Frankfurter Rezeß [Nach 27. Juni 1558]	1558	20/1, p. 458	1324	Other	L	

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
42	Erlaubnis des Magistrats zur Inbesitznahme des Münsters und der Kirche Jung St. Peter für den evangelischen Gottesdienst 17. Mai 1561	1561	20/1, p. 460	1325	Agenda / liturgy	L	
43	Gottesdienstordnung für das Münster [1561-1578]	1578	20/1, p. 461	1326	Agenda / liturgy	L	
44	Weisung des Magistrats an den Kirchenkonvent wegen strittiger Fragen 13. Juli 1562	1562	20/1, p. 466	1327	Consistory / synod / government	L	
45	Entscheidung des Magistrats zur Konfession der Stadt 10. März 1563	1563	20/1, p. 469	1328	Other	L	
46	Die Straßburger Konkordie 18. März 1563	1563	20/1, p. 470	1329	Other	L	
47	Mandat zu den großen und kleinen Bettagen 11. Oktober 1564	1564	20/1, p. 476	1330	Mandate / decree	L	
48	Eheordnung 22. Oktober 1565	1565	20/1, p. 478	1331	Marriage	L	
49	Bekenntniserklärung der Straßburger Geistlichen vor der Übernahme eines Amtes 1565	1565	20/1, p. 480	1332	Confession / doctrine	L	
50	Große Zuchtordnung 11. November 1573	1573	20/1, p. 490	1333	Discipline / police	L	
51	Entscheidung zum Titel des Superintendenten 6. Januar 1574	1574	20/1, p. 499	1334	Consistory / synod / government	L	
52	Vereinbarung zwischen dem Kirchen- und dem Akademiekonvent [31. Dezember 1575]	1575	20/1, p. 502	1335	Consistory / synod / government	L	
53	Gottesdienstordnung [Nach August 1577]	1577	20/1, p. 512	1336	Agenda / liturgy	L	
54	Mandat gegen Schmähschriften und -reden 22. April 1581	1581	20/1, p. 519	1337	Mandate / decree	L	
55	Zwei Ordnungen für die Kirchenpfleger der Gemeinden der Straßburger Landschaft 23. April 1582	1582	20/1, p. 521	1338	Consistory / synod / government	L	
56	Gebet wegen der Verfolgung der Protestanten [1585/1586]	1586	20/1, p. 523	1339	Agenda / liturgy	L	
57	Kirchenordnung für die Pfarreien auf dem Land 24. April 1588	1588	20/1, p. 525	1340	Church order	L	
58	Ordnung der Sonn- und Bettage 15. März 1589	1589	20/1, p. 528	1341	Agenda / liturgy	L	

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
59	Ehegerichtsordnung 25. Juni 1589	1589	20/1, p. 531	1342	Consistory / synod / government	L	
60	Verbot der Konventikel und des auswärtigen Gottesdienstbesuchs 10. Dezember 1597	1597	20/1, p. 535	1343	Mandate / decree	L	
61	Kirchenordnung 9. April 1598	1598	20/1, p. 537	1344	Church order	L	
62	Stellungnahme des Magistrats zur Anfrage des Kirchenkonvents wegen der reformierten Taufpaten und anderer Themen 28. März 1601	1601	20/1, p. 700	1345	Agenda / liturgy	L	
63	Verfügung des Magistrats zu den Predigten bei Begräbnissen 29. April 1609	1609	20/1, p. 701	1346	Agenda / liturgy	L	
64	Mandat zur Beseitigung von Mißbräuchen beim Gottesdienstbesuch 19. Juni 1616	1616	20/1, p. 703	1347	Mandate / decree	L	
65a	Anordnung des Magistrats zur Feier des Reformationsjubiläums 15. Oktober 1617	1617	20/1, p. 704	1348	Mandate / decree	L	
65b	Gebete zum Reformationsjubiläum [Zwischen 15. Oktober und 1. November 1617]	1617	20/1, p. 707	1349	Agenda / liturgy	L	

1.31 Volume 20/2: Alsace II: territories and imperial cities

84 texts.

1.31.1 County of Hanau-Lichtenberg

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
1	Acht Reformationsartikel 14. März [15]45	n.d.	20/2, p. 37	1359	Other	L	
2	Verpflichtung der Geistlichen zur Teilnahme an der ersten Synode [14. Mai] 1545	1545	20/2, p. 39	1360	Consistory / synod / government	L	
3	Eheordnung 2. April 1565	1565	20/2, p. 40	1361	Marriage	L	
4	Befehl zur Unterdrückung der Messe 17. September 1570	1570	20/2, p. 46	1362	Mandate / decree	L	
5	Verpflichtungserklärung der Pfarrer bei ihrem Amtsantritt 1570	1570	20/2, p. 47	1363	Appointment / oath	L	

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
6	Kirchenordnung 1573	1573	20/2, p. 48	1364	Church order	L	
7	Schulordnung 1614	1614	20/2, p. 82	1365	School / university	L	

1.31.2 Lordship of Fleckenstein

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
1	Zuchtmandat [ohne Datum]	n.d.	20/2, p. 107	1370	Discipline / police	L	

1.31.3 Lordship of Rappoltstein

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.
- **Note**: The French refugee congregation in the Lebertal was Reformed.
- **Texts by tradition**: Reformed 10, Lutheran 2.

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
2	Schulordnung für Rappoltsweiler [ca. 1565 bzw. vor 17. Dezember 1567]	1567	20/2, p. 109	1370	School / university	L	
3	Zuchtordnung [um 1553]	1553	20/2, p. 112	1370	Discipline / police	L	
4	Bekenntnis der französischen Gemeinde im Lebertal [1558]	1558	20/2, p. 117	1370	Confession / doctrine	R	French Reformed congregation in the Lebertal
5	Ordnung für das Prebyterium [1558 / 1559]	1559	20/2, p. 123	1370	Local order	R	French Reformed congregation in the Lebertal
6	Bericht des Predigers Pierre Marboeuf über die Lehre der französischen Gemeinde [1560]	1560	20/2, p. 125	1370	Mandate / decree	R	French Reformed congregation in the Lebertal
7	Vergleich zwischen der deutschen und der französischen Gemeinde 28. Mai 1561	1561	20/2, p. 132	1370	Treaty / agreement	R	French Reformed congregation in the Lebertal
8	Bericht des Predigers Arnaud Banc über die Lehre der französischen Gemeinde [Ende Juni / Anfang Juli 1561]	1561	20/2, p. 136	1371	Mandate / decree	R	French Reformed congregation in the Lebertal
9a	Bekenntnis des Predigers der französischen Gemeinde Nicolas François 16. Juli 1562	1562	20/2, p. 146	1371	Confession / doctrine	R	French Reformed congregation in the Lebertal
9b	Revers des Predigers 17. Juli 1562	1562	20/2, p. 147	1371	Appointment / oath	R	French Reformed congregation in the Lebertal

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
9c	Vom Prediger abgelehnte Artikel [27. Juli 1562]	1562	20/2, p. 148	1371	Other	R	French Reformed congregation in the Lebertal
10a	Verpflichtungserklärung für den Prediger der französischen Gemeinde [1569]	1569	20/2, p. 149	1371	Appointment / oath	R	French Reformed congregation in the Lebertal
10b	Bestallungsurkunde für den Prediger 1569	1569	20/2, p. 150	1371	Appointment / oath	R	French Reformed congregation in the Lebertal

1.31.4 Imperial city of Mülhausen (Mulhouse)

- **Tradition**: Reformed.
- **Note**: Allied with the Swiss; a Zwinglian, later Swiss Reformed, church.

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
1	Mandat zur Predigt des Evangeliums 25. bzw. 29. Juli 1523	1523	20/2, p. 187	1375	Mandate / decree	R	
2	Zuchtordnung [Ende 1523 / Anfang 1524]	1524	20/2, p. 189	1376	Discipline / police	R	
3a	Bittschrift der Zunftmeister betreffend die Versorgung des Prädikanten, die Verwendung der deutschen Sprache im Gottesdienst und andere Themen [vor …	1524	20/2, p. 191	1376	Agenda / liturgy	R	
3b	Stellungnahme des Rates zu den Forderungen der neuen Zunftmeister [nach 11. Januar 1524]	1524	20/2, p. 193	1376	Other	R	
4	Verordnungen zu den Prozessionen und Feiertagen [vor 28. April 1524]	1524	20/2, p. 195	1377	Discipline / police	R	
5	Anweisungen für den Schulmeister und die Kapläne 28. April 1524	1524	20/2, p. 197	1378	School / university	R	
6a	Anfrage des Komturs des Deutschordenshauses zur Tätigkeit des Leutpriesters 27. Juli [1524]	1524	20/2, p. 199	1378	Other	R	
6b	Stellungnahme des Rates zur Anfrage des Komturs [nach 27. Juli 1524]	1524	20/2, p. 202	1378	Other	R	
7	Rechtfertigung der reformatorischen Neuerungen durch den Magistrat 1. Juli 1527	1527	20/2, p. 204	1379	Other	R	
8	Im Auftrag des Rates erstelltes Gutachten des Leutpriesters und der beiden Prädikanten zu den Gottesdiensten in der Karwoche [März 1528]	1528	20/2, p. 206	1380	Agenda / liturgy	R	
9	Im Auftrag des Rates erstelltes Gutachten des Leutpriesters und der drei Prädikanten zur Gestaltung der Gottesdienste [vor 24. Dezember 1528]	1528	20/2, p. 208	1381	Agenda / liturgy	R	

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
10	Gutachten des Leutpriesters und der Prädikanten zu den ihnen vorgelegten Basler und Straßburger Ordnungen [um den 26. November 1529]	1529	20/2, p. 213	1382	Mandate / decree	R	
11	Eheordnung [1530 / 1534]	1534	20/2, p. 218	1383	Marriage	R	
12	Entscheidung zur Wittenberger Konkordie 9. November 1536	1536	20/2, p. 225	1384	Other	R	
13	Mandat zur Predigt des Evangeliums und zur Unterbindung verschiedener Mißbräuche Januar 1537	1537	20/2, p. 227	1385	Mandate / decree	R	
14	Bekenntnis der Stadt Mülhausen [21. Januar ?] 1537	1537	20/2, p. 229	1386	Confession / doctrine	R	
15	Stellungnahme der Geistlichen zu der ihnen vorgelegten Basler Synodalordnung 25. Dezember 1540	1540	20/2, p. 235	1387	Consistory / synod / government	R	
16	Beschluß zur Aufrichtung einer christlichen Ordnung 26. Januar 1541	1541	20/2, p. 241	1388	Mandate / decree	R	
17	Zuchtordnung 12. November 1545	1545	20/2, p. 245	1389	Discipline / police	R	
18a	Eide der Prädikanten und des Schulmeisters: Eid der Prädikanten 1551	1551	20/2, p. 248	1390	Appointment / oath	R	
18b	Eide der Prädikanten und des Schulmeisters: Eid des Schulmeisters 1551	1551	20/2, p. 251	1390	School / university	R	
19	Eheordnung 1555	1555	20/2, p. 253	1391	Marriage	R	
20	Anweisung an die Prädikanten 24. Juni 1557	1557	20/2, p. 260	1392	Mandate / decree	R	
21	Sonntagsmandat 30. April 1561	1561	20/2, p. 264	1393	Discipline / police	R	
22	Agende 1564	1564	20/2, p. 268	1394	Agenda / liturgy	R	
23	Katechismus 1580	1580	20/2, p. 284	1395	Catechism / instruction	R	
24	Zuchtordnung 18. März 1582	1582	20/2, p. 305	1396	Discipline / police	R	

1.31.5 Imperial city of Weißenburg (Alsace)

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
1	Vertrag zwischen dem Stift und der Stadt Weißenburg 12. April 1560	1560	20/2, p. 317	1399	Monastery / chapter	L	
2	Zuchtordnung 10. Dezember 1613	1613	20/2, p. 320	1399	Discipline / police	L	

1.31.6 Münster im Gregoriental

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
1	Kientzheimer Vertrag 19. März 1575	1575	20/2, p. 353	1402	Treaty / agreement	L	
2	Kirchenordnung [26. August bzw. 4. September 1575 / nach 9. August 1580]	1580	20/2, p. 369	1402	Church order	L	
3	Ordnung für das Ehegericht 1577	1577	20/2, p. 383	1402	Consistory / synod / government	L	
4	Mandat zum Kirchenbann 13. September 1578	1578	20/2, p. 388	1402	Mandate / decree	L	
5	Ordnung für die Schulmeister 31. Oktober 1578	1578	20/2, p. 393	1402	School / university	L	
6	Sittenmandat 24. Juni 1580	1580	20/2, p. 396	1402	Discipline / police	L	
7	Anweisung des Rates zu den Predigten 3. November 1604	1604	20/2, p. 398	1402	Mandate / decree	L	

1.31.7 Imperial city of Hagenau

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
1	Mitteilung über die Einführung des evangelischen Gottesdienstes und die Anstellung eines evangelischen Pfarrers [9. November 1565]	1565	20/2, p. 421	1405	Agenda / liturgy	L	
2	Bestellung eines evangelischen Pfarrers 9. November 1565	1565	20/2, p. 425	1405	Appointment / oath	L	
3	Vorrede Jakob Andreäs zur Sammlung seiner in Hagenau bei Einführung der Reformation gehaltenen Predigten 24. Juni 1566	1566	20/2, p. 429	1405	Other	L	
4	Brief der Stadt Hagenau an Kaiser Maximilian II. zur Rechtfertigung der Einführung der Reformation [nach 22. Oktober 1566]	1566	20/2, p. 435	1405	Other	L	
5	Zuchtordnung 29. Oktober 1571	1571	20/2, p. 441	1405	Discipline / police	L	

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
6	Vereinbarung zwischen der Stadt Hagenau und der Reichslandvogtei in Religionsfragen 26. Juli 1578	1578	20/2, p. 448	1405	Treaty / agreement	L	
7	Mandat gegen Kuppelei und heimliche Eheabsprachen 22. Februar 1587	1587	20/2, p. 452	1405	Mandate / decree	L	
8	Verbot jeglicher Angriffe und Diskussionen wegen der Religion 3. Juni 1588	1588	20/2, p. 454	1405	Mandate / decree	L	
9	Erklärung der evangelischen Ratsmitglieder 11. / 21. April 1603	1603	20/2, p. 455	1405	Mandate / decree	L	
10	Verbot jeglicher Angriffe und Diskussionen wegen der Religion 5. April 1610	1610	20/2, p. 461	1405	Mandate / decree	L	
11	Fundationsbrief der evangelischen Kirche und Schule in Hagenau 3. Juni 1614	1614	20/2, p. 463	1405	School / university	L	
12	Verbot jeglicher Angriffe und Diskussionen wegen der Religion 8. Mai 1617	1617	20/2, p. 466	1405	Mandate / decree	L	

1.31.8 Imperial city of Colmar

- **Tradition**: Lutheran; Moderate Reformed from 1578.
- **Note**: The Reformation came in 1575 with pastors from Basel (Serinus, on Simon Sulzer's advice) and the Württemberg agenda; Colmar refused the Formula of Concord (1578), and by the early 17th century its church was Reformed.
- **Texts by tradition**: Moderate Reformed 12, Lutheran 4.

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
1	Gutachten des Straßburger Syndikus Johannes Nervius zur Einführung der Reformation Mai 1575	1575	20/2, p. 491	1408	Mandate / decree	L	
2	Eid der Prediger [22. Oktober 1575]	1575	20/2, p. 501	1408	Appointment / oath	L	
3	Feiertagsmandat 22. Oktober 1575	1575	20/2, p. 503	1408	Discipline / police	L	
4	Zuchtordnung [1575]	1575	20/2, p. 505	1408	Discipline / police	L	
5	Ablehnung des Beitritts zur Konkordienformel 10. Mai 1578	1578	20/2, p. 509	1408	Other	MR	
6	Eid der Mitglieder des Ehegerichts [nach 1581]	1581	20/2, p. 511	1408	Consistory / synod / government	MR	
7	Mandat zu den Kreuzgängen 4. Juni 1588	1588	20/2, p. 512	1408	Mandate / decree	MR	
8a	Deklarationsschrift. Erläuterung zu den Artikeln 10 und 13 der Confessio Augustana [22. Dezember 1589]	1589	20/2, p. 513	1408	Confession / doctrine	MR	

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
8b	Gutachten der Weißenburger Prädikanten zur Colmarer Deklarationsschrift 25. Juli 1590	1590	20/2, p. 519	1408	Mandate / decree	MR	
9	Eid der Prediger [3. Februar 1590]	1590	20/2, p. 523	1408	Appointment / oath	MR	
10	Eheordnung [vor 1593]	1593	20/2, p. 525	1408	Marriage	MR	
11	Mandat gegen Gotteslästerung [vor 1593]	1593	20/2, p. 528	1408	Mandate / decree	MR	
12	Hochzeitsmandat 11. April 1601	1601	20/2, p. 529	1408	Marriage	MR	
13	Gottesdienstordnung [zwischen 11. Januar 1601 und 6. Oktober 1603]	1603	20/2, p. 530	1408	Agenda / liturgy	MR	
14	Hochzeitsmandat 3. Dezember 1608	1608	20/2, p. 532	1408	Marriage	MR	
15	Eid der Prediger [25. April 1615]	1615	20/2, p. 535	1408	Appointment / oath	MR	

1.32 Volume 21: North Rhine-Westphalia I: Jülich-Cleves-Berg, Lippe and others

52 texts.

1.32.1 United Duchies of Jülich-Cleves-Berg

- **Tradition**: Roman Catholic humanist (Erasmian).
- **Note**: An Erasmian Catholic reform (orders of 1532/1533), not a Protestant church order.

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
2	Kirchenordnung 1532/	1532	21, p. 33	1420	Church order	RCH	
1	Kirchenordnung 1525	1525	21, p. 49	1421	Church order	RCH	
2a	Kirchenordnung 1532	1532	21, p. 52	1421	Church order	RCH	
2b	Kirchenordnung 1532/: Visitationsinstruktion [1532]	1532	21, p. 57	1421	Visitation	RCH	
2c	Kirchenordnung 1532/: Deklaration zur Kirchenordnung 1533	1533	21, p. 60	1421	Church order	RCH	
3a	Mandat gegen Täufer und Anhänger anderer abweichender Lehren 1534	1534	21, p. 73	1421	Mandate / decree	RCH	
3b	Täufermandate: Mandat gegen Täufer aus Münster 1535	1535	21, p. 75	1421	Mandate / decree	RCH	
4	Mandat gegen Prozessionen 1554	1554	21, p. 77	1422	Mandate / decree	RCH	
5	Armenordnung 1554	1554	21, p. 78	1423	Poor relief	RCH	

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
6	Abendmahlsmandat [um 1558]	1558	21, p. 81	1424	Agenda / liturgy	RCH	
7	Visitationsinstruktion 1559	1559	21, p. 84	1425	Visitation	RCH	
8	Mandat zum Lebenswandel der Geistlichen 1562	1562	21, p. 90	1426	Mandate / decree	RCH	
9a	Mandat gegen Täufer und Anhänger anderer abweichender Lehren 1565	1565	21, p. 91	1426	Mandate / decree	RCH	
9b	Täufermandat: Ausführungsbefehl zum Täufermandat 1565	1565	21, p. 96	1426	Discipline / police	RCH	
10	Mandat gegen fremde Prediger [1567]	1567	21, p. 97	1427	Mandate / decree	RCH	
11	Mandat gegen eigenmächtige Neuerungen durch die Geistlichen 1567	1567	21, p. 99	1428	Mandate / decree	RCH	
12	Mandat zur ordentlichen Approbation der Geistlichen 1570	1570	21, p. 100	1429	Mandate / decree	RCH	
13	Mandat zu kirchlichen Zeremonien 1572	1572	21, p. 101	1430	Mandate / decree	RCH	

1.32.2 Bishopric and town of Minden

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
1	Überschreibung des Dominikanerklosters St. Paul an den Rat 1530	1530	21, p. 119	1433	Monastery / chapter	L	
2	Kirchenordnung 1530	1530	21, p. 121	1434	Church order	L	
3	Vertrag zwischen der Stadt Minden und dem Domkapitel 1535	1535	21, p. 146	1435	Treaty / agreement	L	
4	Polizeiordnung 1566	1566	21, p. 149	1436	Discipline / police	L	
5	Lübbecker Rezess 1573	1573	21, p. 151	1437	Treaty / agreement	L	
6	Festlegung des evangelischen Bekenntnisstands im Fürstbistum 1583	1583	21, p. 154	1438	Confession / doctrine	L	
7	Polizeiordnung 1604	1604	21, p. 155	1439	Discipline / police	L	

1.32.3 Imperial abbey and town of Herford

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
1	Kirchenordnung 1532	1532	21, p. 165	1442	Church order	L	

1.32.4 Imperial city of Dortmund

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
1	Mandat zur Zulassung evangelischer Predigt 1532	1532	21, p. 207	1445	Mandate / decree	L	
2	Gottesdienstordnung 1554	1554	21, p. 208	1446	Agenda / liturgy	L	
3	Mandat zur Freigabe des Abendmahls unter beiderlei Gestalt 1562	1562	21, p. 216	1447	Mandate / decree	L	
4	Mandat zur Zulassung deutscher Gottesdienste 1564	1564	21, p. 218	1448	Mandate / decree	L	
5	Mandat gegen Täufer und Anhänger anderer abweichender Lehren 1570	1570	21, p. 219	1449	Mandate / decree	L	
6	Armenordnung 1596	1596	21, p. 221	1450	Poor relief	L	

1.32.5 Imperial abbey of Corvey (Höxter)

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
1	Vertrag zwischen dem Petersstift und der Stadt Höxter 1533	1533	21, p. 235	1453	Monastery / chapter	L	
2	Vertrag zwischen dem Petersstift und der Stadt Höxter 1536	1536	21, p. 237	1454	Monastery / chapter	L	
3	Kirchenordnung für das Corveyer Stiftsdorf Bruchhausen 1603	1603	21, p. 240	1455	Church order	L	

1.32.6 County of Lippe

- **Tradition**: Lutheran; Reformed from 1600.
- **Note**: Lutheran (1538) until Simon VI's 'Second Reformation' after 1600; Lemgo stayed Lutheran.
- **Texts by tradition**: Lutheran 11, Reformed 1.

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
1	Lemgoer Kirchenordnung 1537	1537	21, p. 301	1458	Church order	L	
2	Lippische Kirchenordnung 1538	1538	21, p. 306	1459	Church order	L	

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
3	Kirchenordnung des Antonius Corvinus [1542]	1542	21, p. 344	1460	Church order	L	
4a	Die Revision der Kirchenordnung von 1538: Zeremonienordnung [1542]	1542	21, p. 351	1460	Agenda / liturgy	L	
4b	Die Revision der Kirchenordnung von 1538: Ordinationsordnung [1542]	1542	21, p. 359	1460	Agenda / liturgy	L	
4c	Die Revision der Kirchenordnung von 1538: Zuchtordnung [1542]	1542	21, p. 361	1460	Discipline / police	L	
4d	Die Revision der Kirchenordnung von 1538: Ausschreiben zur revidierten Kirchenordnung 1559	1559	21, p. 366	1460	Church order	L	
4e	Die Revision der Kirchenordnung von 1538: Ausschreiben zur revidierten Kirchenordnung 1564	1564	21, p. 368	1460	Church order	L	
5	Visitationsinstruktion 1566	1566	21, p. 371	1461	Visitation	L	
6	Kirchenordnung 1571	1571	21, p. 373	1462	Church order	L	
7	Visitations-, Konsistorial- und Ehegerichtsordnung 1600	1600	21, p. 462	1462	Visitation	R	
8	Röhrentruper Rezess 1617	1617	21, p. 484	1462	Treaty / agreement	L	guarantees Lemgo's Lutheran confession

1.32.7 Imperial abbey and town of Essen

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
1	Ratsbeschluss zum deutschen Psalmengesang in St. Gertrud 1561	1561	21, p. 497	1465	Mandate / decree	L	
2	Ratsmandat, Personen geistlichen Standes nicht zu beschimpfen [1563]	1563	21, p. 498	1466	Mandate / decree	L	
3	Predigerartikel 1571	1571	21, p. 499	1467	Other	L	
4	Mandat zu Winkelpredigten und Sonntagsheiligung 1573	1573	21, p. 503	1468	Mandate / decree	L	
5	Armenordnung 1581	1581	21, p. 504	1469	Poor relief	L	

1.33 Volume 22: North Rhine-Westphalia II: Cologne, Wittgenstein, Bentheim, Soest and others

65 texts.

1.33.1 Archbishopric of Cologne

- **Tradition**: Moderate Reformed; Reformed from 1583.
- **Note**: Hermann von Wied's Reformation attempt (1542-1547; Bucer and Melanchthon); Gebhard Truchsess's attempt (1583) was backed by the Reformed.
- **Texts by tradition**: Reformed 2, Moderate Reformed 1.

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
1	Buß-, Fasten-, Bet- und Danktagsordnung 1546	1546	22, p. 41	1484	Agenda / liturgy	MR	
2	Edikt zur evangelischen Religionsausübung 1583	1583	22, p. 47	1485	Mandate / decree	R	
3	Ausschreiben zur freien Religionsausübung 1583	1583	22, p. 50	1486	Mandate / decree	R	

1.33.2 County of Wittgenstein

- **Tradition**: Lutheran; Reformed from 1574.
- **Note**: Reformed from about 1574.
- **Texts by tradition**: Lutheran 11, Reformed 10.

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
1a	Buß-, Fasten-, Bet- und Danktagsordnung 1546: Kirchenordnung 1555: Kirchenordnung	1555	22, p. 79	1491	Church order	L	
1b	Kirchenordnung 1555: Mandate zur Einberufung der Synode	1555	22, p. 94	1493	Mandate / decree	L	
1c	Kirchenordnung 1555: Anweisungen für die Rentmeister	1555	22, p. 95	1493	Mandate / decree	L	
2	Kirchenordnung 1563	1563	22, p. 96	1493	Church order	L	
3	Kirchenordnung [1565]	1565	22, p. 107	1493	Church order	L	
4	Mandat, die Kirchenordnung zu beachten 1569	1569	22, p. 119	1493	Church order	L	
5	Synodalbeschluss 1569	1569	22, p. 120	1493	Consistory / synod / government	L	
6	Hofordnung 1570	1570	22, p. 121	1493	Other	L	
7	Polizeiordnung 1573	1573	22, p. 124	1493	Discipline / police	L	
8	Eheordnung 1579	1579	22, p. 127	1493	Marriage	R	
9a	Mandate zu Pfarrgütern und Gottesdiensten 1584: Mandat, die Pfarrgüter zu schützen	1584	22, p. 131	1493	Mandate / decree	R	
9b	Mandat zu Gottesdiensten, Katechismusunterricht und Pfarrgütern	1584	22, p. 133	1493	Mandate / decree	R	

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
10	Synodalprotokoll 1585	1585	22, p. 134	1493	Consistory / synod / government	R	
11	Gerichts- und Polizeiordnung für die Herrschaft Homburg 1562/1563	1563	22, p. 135	1493	Discipline / police	L	
12	Hochzeits- und Taufordnung für die Herrschaft Homburg 1570	1570	22, p. 137	1493	Agenda / liturgy	L	
13	Kirchenzuchtordnung für die Herrschaft Homburg [1605]	1605	22, p. 139	1493	Discipline / police	R	
14	Mandat zur Einführung des reformierten Bekenntnisses in der Herrschaft Homburg 1605	1605	22, p. 145	1493	Mandate / decree	R	
15	Mandat zur Anstellung des Predigers Albert Schnabel in Marienhagen 1605	1605	22, p. 146	1493	Mandate / decree	R	
16	Beschlüsse zu Homburger Kirchensachen [1605]	1605	22, p. 147	1493	Other	R	
17	Mandat zu kirchlichen Belangen in der Herrschaft Homburg 1606	1606	22, p. 150	1494	Mandate / decree	R	
18	Täufermandat für die Herrschaft Homburg 1611	1611	22, p. 152	1494	Discipline / police	R	

1.33.3 County of Moers

- **Tradition**: Lutheran; Reformed from 1578.
- **Note**: Reformed under Count Adolf (1578-1589).
- **Texts by tradition**: Lutheran 3, Reformed 3.

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
1	Mandat zur Anstellung eines evangelischen Predigers in Krefeld 1561	1561	22, p. 169	1497	Mandate / decree	L	
2	Mandat zur Besetzung der Pfarrstelle in Krefeld 1565	1565	22, p. 170	1498	Mandate / decree	L	
3	Mandat zur Umwandlung des Karmeliterklosters in eine Schule [1573]	1573	22, p. 171	1499	Mandate / decree	L	
4	Polizeiordnung 1574/1580/1581	1581	22, p. 173	1500	Discipline / police	R	
5	Kirchenordnung [1581]	1581	22, p. 179	1502	Church order	R	
6	Kanzelabkündigung zur Kirchenordnung 1603	1603	22, p. 216	1502	Church order	R	

1.33.4 County of Bentheim-Tecklenburg

- **Tradition**: Lutheran; Reformed from 1586.

- **Note**: Reformed from the 1580s (order of 1588).
- **Texts by tradition**: Reformed 10, Lutheran 2.

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
1	Tecklenburger Kirchenordnung 1543	1543	22, p. 241	1505	Church order	L	
2	Ordnung für das Tecklenburger Zisterzienserinnenkloster Leeden 1585	1585	22, p. 247	1506	Monastery / chapter	L	
3	Bentheim-Tecklenburger Kirchenordnung 1588/1619	1619	22, p. 249	1507	Church order	R	
4	Tecklenburger Polizeiordnung 1601/1612	1612	22, p. 298	1508	Discipline / police	R	
5	Mandat zum Glockenläuten bei Gottesdiensten und Begräbnissen 1601	1601	22, p. 302	1508	Mandate / decree	R	
6	Mandat zu Klassikalkonventen, Generalsynoden und Kirchenorganisation 1604	1604	22, p. 304	1508	Mandate / decree	R	
7	Einrichtung des Steinfurter Ehegerichts 1606	1606	22, p. 306	1508	Consistory / synod / government	R	
8a	Die Bentheimer Artikel: Bentheimer Glaubensartikel [1613]	1613	22, p. 308	1508	Confession / doctrine	R	
8b	Die Bentheimer Artikel: Bestätigung des Heidelberger Katechismus 1617	1617	22, p. 311	1508	Catechism / instruction	R	
8c	Die Bentheimer Artikel: Bestätigung der Glaubensartikel 1619	1619	22, p. 313	1508	Confession / doctrine	R	
9	Mandat zur Einsetzung des Oberkirchenrats in der Grafschaft Bentheim 1613	1613	22, p. 314	1508	Mandate / decree	R	
10	Einrichtung des Kirchenrats in Rheda 1619	1619	22, p. 316	1508	Consistory / synod / government	R	

1.33.5 County of Rietberg

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
1	Polizeiordnung 1566	1566	22, p. 329	1513	Discipline / police	L	
2	Anstellungsurkunde für den Rietberger Pfarrer Simon Hagemann 1568	1568	22, p. 332	1514	Appointment / oath	L	

1.33.6 City of Münster

- **Tradition**: Moderate Reformed.
- **Note**: Bernhard Rothmann's evangelical order moved from Lutheran to Zwinglian views before the Anabaptist kingdom of 1534/35.

- **Texts by tradition**: Moderate Reformed 4, Anabaptist (toleration) 1, Roman Catholic 1.

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
1	Vereinbarung von Rat und Gemeinde über Anstellung evangelischer Prediger an den Stadtkirchen 1532	1532	22, p. 347	1518	Appointment / oath	MR	
2	Vertrag von Bischof und Stadt zur Reformation 1533	1533	22, p. 349	1519	Treaty / agreement	MR	
3	Zuchtordnung 1533	1533	22, p. 354	1520	Discipline / police	MR	
4	Summarium der Kirchenordnung [1533]	1533	22, p. 361	1521	Church order	MR	
5	Mandat zur Duldung der Täufer 1534	1534	22, p. 363	1522	Mandate / decree	ANA	the council and guilds let each keep his faith, recognizing the Anabaptists (31 January 1534)
6	Bischöfliches Edikt gegen die Täufer 1534	1534	22, p. 364	1523	Discipline / police	RC	Bishop Franz von Waldeck's edict

1.33.7 City of Soest

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.
- **Interim**: 1 text(s) tied to the Augsburg Interim (see the last column).

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
1	Kirchenordnung 1532	1532	22, p. 385	1527	Church order	L	
2	Mandat zur Residenzpflicht der Pfarrer und zur evangelischen Predigt 1532	1532	22, p. 460	1528	Mandate / decree	L	
3	Die „Lätareartikel“ 1533	1533	22, p. 462	1529	Other	L	
4	Ordnung für das Kloster St. Walburgis 1543	1543	22, p. 465	1530	Monastery / chapter	L	
5	Mandat zum Abendmahl unter beiderlei Gestalt 1552	1552	22, p. 472	1531	Mandate / decree	L	**After the Interim**
6	Anstellungsartikel für die Prediger 1554	1554	22, p. 474	1532	Appointment / oath	L	
7	Armenordnung 1581	1581	22, p. 475	1533	Poor relief	L	
8	Anweisung zu den Taufpaten 1583	1583	22, p. 478	1534	Agenda / liturgy	L	
9	Eheordnung 1583	1583	22, p. 479	1535	Marriage	L	

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
10	Artikel der Prediger 1590	1590	22, p. 480	1536	Articles / statutes	L	
11	Armenordnung 1597	1597	22, p. 482	1537	Poor relief	L	
12	Kirchenordnung [1609]	1609	22, p. 484	1538	Church order	L	
13	Kirchenordnung für die Soester Börde 1609/1619	1619	22, p. 498	1539	Church order	L	

1.33.8 Town of Neuenrade

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
1	Kirchenordnung 1564	1564	22, p. 515	1544	Church order	L	

1.33.9 County of Lippe (supplement)

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
1	Deutsche Messe [ca. 1525-1538]	1538	22, p. 565	1549	Agenda / liturgy	L	

1.34 Volume 23: Schleswig-Holstein and Dithmarschen

88 texts.

1.34.1 Duchies of Schleswig and Holstein

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
1	Deutsche Messe [nach 1526]	1526	23, p. 55	1576	Agenda / liturgy	L	
2	Bestätigung des zwischen der Gemeinde und den Geistlichen von Husum geschlossenen Vertrags durch König Friedrich I. 17. November 1527	1527	23, p. 60	1576	Treaty / agreement	L	
3	Hadersiebener Artikel [1528]	1528	23, p. 62	1576	Other	L	
4	Anweisung zur Verwendung von Geldern des Hadersiebener Domes für den Unterhalt der Kirchen- und Schuldiener sowie für die Versorgung der Armen 25. …	1533	23, p. 69	1576	School / university	L	
5	Verordnung über Superintendenten und Geistliche in den Ämtern Flensburg und Tondern April 1540	1540	23, p. 72	1576	Consistory / synod / government	L	

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
6	Anweisung für die Visitatoren der Klöster 6. Januar 1541	1541	23, p. 76	1576	Visitation	L	
7	Kirchenordnung 1542	1542	23, p. 80	1576	Church order	L	
8	Schulordnung 25. Mai 1544	1544	23, p. 151	1576	School / university	L	
9	Eheordnung 24. Juni 1544	1544	23, p. 155	1576	Marriage	L	
1	Mandat gegen Täufer und Sakramentierer 1. August 1555	1555	23, p. 171	1580	Mandate / decree	L	
2	Mandat gegen Täufer 15. März 1562	1562	23, p. 173	1581	Mandate / decree	L	
3	Anordnung zum Vollzug des Abschieds des Lüneburger Kreistages 21. Juni 1562	1562	23, p. 175	1582	Treaty / agreement	L	
4	Einrichtung eines Almosenkastens in den Kirchen zur Versorgung der Versehrten der Türkenkriege 1. Oktober 1595	1595	23, p. 179	1583	Poor relief	L	
5	Klosterordnung für die noch bestehenden Frauenkonvente [nach 1610]	1610	23, p. 181	1584	Consistory / synod / government	L	
1	Zuchtordnung für die Ämter Hadersleben und Törning 15. Mai 1550	1550	23, p. 207	1586	Discipline / police	L	
2	Anweisung an den Adel zur Einhaltung der Sonn- und Feiertage durch deren Untertanen März 1551	1551	23, p. 210	1587	Discipline / police	L	
3	Mandat für die Landschaft Nordstrand zur Berufung und Absetzung von Geistlichen Februar 1553	1553	23, p. 211	1588	Mandate / decree	L	
4	Anweisung zur Abhaltung von Bettagen 3. März 1553	1553	23, p. 213	1589	Agenda / liturgy	L	
5	Kirchenordnung für die Landschaft Nordstrand [22. Juli 1556]	1556	23, p. 215	1590	Church order	L	
6	Mandat zum Unterhalt der Geistlichen und der Kirchen und zum Umgang mit dem Kirchenland im Amt Tondern 25. Juli 1556	1556	23, p. 221	1591	Mandate / decree	L	
7	Mandat zur Entrichtung des Zehnten für die Propstei Hadersleben 6. August 1561	1561	23, p. 223	1592	Mandate / decree	L	
8	Einsetzung von Disziplinaraufsehern in den Pfarreien der Ämter Hadersleben und Törning Juni 1564	1564	23, p. 225	1593	Other	L	
9a	Anweisung für das zukünftige Verhalten der Mönche im Kloster Bordesholm 31. Mai 1565	1565	23, p. 227	1594	Monastery / chapter	L	

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
9b	Reformation des Klosters Bordesholm 16. März 1566	1566	23, p. 228	1594	Church order	L	
10	Mandat für die Propstei Hadersleben zu Kirchenregistern und Kirchenrechnung 4. April 1568	1568	23, p. 232	1595	Mandate / decree	L	
11	Erstattung von Aufwendungen für die Pfarrhäuser durch die Amtsnachfolger 2. September 1569	1569	23, p. 234	1596	Other	L	
12	Verordnung zum Kirchen- und Armenwesen in Rendsburg 20. September 1571	1571	23, p. 236	1597	Poor relief	L	
13	Mandat zu den Kirchenstühlen in Hadersleben 31. Mai 1571	1571	23, p. 242	1598	Mandate / decree	L	
14	Zuchtordnung für das Amt Rendsburg und die Angehörigen des Klosters Bordesholm Februar 1573	1573	23, p. 243	1599	Monastery / chapter	L	
1	Mandat für die Kremper und Wilster Marsch wegen der Entrichtung der Abgaben zur Versorgung der Geistlichen und Lehrer 23. März 1547	1547	23, p. 265	1600	Mandate / decree	L	
2	Anweisung an die Geistlichen der Kremper und Wilster Marsch zum Gehorsam gegenüber dem Propst 23. März 1547	1547	23, p. 267	1601	Mandate / decree	L	
3a	Anweisung zur Abhaltung von drei Bettagen 28. Februar 1553	1553	23, p. 269	1602	Agenda / liturgy	L	
3b	Mandat zur Durchführung von drei Bettagen 21. Dezember 1557	1557	23, p. 271	1603	Mandate / decree	L	
4	Anweisung für die Pfarrer des Herzogtums Holstein wegen der Täufer und anderer Sektierer November 1553	1553	23, p. 273	1604	Discipline / police	L	
5a	Vergleich zum Gnadenjahr der Pfarrwitwen des Münsterdorfer Kalands [1559]	1559	23, p. 275	1605	Poor relief	L	
5b	Entscheidung zur Ausgestaltung des Gnadenjahres der Pfarrwitwen des Segeberger Kalands Juni 1596	1596	23, p. 276	1605	Poor relief	L	
6	Kirchenordnung von Heiligenstedten 1564	1564	23, p. 278	1606	Church order	L	
7	Bestimmungen des Münsterdorfer Konsistoriums zur Eheschließung 13. Januar 1565	1565	23, p. 280	1607	Consistory / synod / government	L	
8	Mandat wegen der Entrichtung des Zehnten und anderer Abgaben im Amt Flensburg August 1574	1574	23, p. 282	1608	Mandate / decree	L	
9	Statuten des Münsterdorfer Kalands 1574	1574	23, p. 284	1609	Discipline / police	L	

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
10	Befehl an den Statthalter Heinrich Rantzau wegen der Bettage 24. Januar 1581	1581	23, p. 287	1611	Mandate / decree	L	
11	Zuchtordnung für das Amt Flensburg 24. November 1605	1605	23, p. 288	1611	Discipline / police	L	
12	Mandat zur Bestrafung der Personen, die nicht am Abendmahl teilnehmen 21. Juli 1614	1614	23, p. 292	1612	Mandate / decree	L	
1	Vertrag zwischen Herzog Adolf I. und dem Domkapitel in Schleswig wegen der Wahl des Herzogs zum Administrator des Bistums Schleswig 31. Juli 1556	1556	23, p. 327	1613	Treaty / agreement	L	
2	Mandat für die Visitatoren 2. August 1557	1557	23, p. 333	1615	Mandate / decree	L	
3	Bekenntnis der Geistlichen der Landschaft Eiderstedt [3. August] 1557	1557	23, p. 335	1616	Confession / doctrine	L	
4a	Bestallung Pauls von Eitzen zum Rat und Diener von Haus aus 10. Juni 1561	1561	23, p. 339	1617	Appointment / oath	L	
4b	Eid des Schleswiger Superintendenten Paul von Eitzen 1562	1562	23, p. 340	1617	Consistory / synod / government	L	
5	Katechismus des Paul von Eitzen 1571	1571	23, p. 341	1618	Catechism / instruction	L	
6	Eid der Gottorfer Prediger [vor 15. September 1574]	1574	23, p. 364	1618	Appointment / oath	L	
7	Ordinationsbescheinigungen 22. März 1583 / 7. April 1611	1611	23, p. 366	1619	Agenda / liturgy	L	
8a	Anweisung für die Visitatoren zur Durchführung einer Generalvisitation und zur Einsetzung von Pröpsten 21. Februar 1587	1587	23, p. 368	1619	Visitation	L	
8b	Mandat wegen der Entrichtung des Zehnten und anderer Abgaben im Amt Flensburg August 1574: Visitationsartikel 1587	1587	23, p. 371	1621	Visitation	L	
9	Berufung von Johannes Pistorius zum Hofprediger 8. Oktober 1588	1588	23, p. 374	1621	Appointment / oath	L	
10	Beauftragung des Propstes Jakob Fabricius mit der Examination und der Ordination der Kirchendiener sowie der jährlichen Visitation von Nordstrand 28. …	1593	23, p. 376	1622	Agenda / liturgy	L	
11	Kirchenordnung für das Amt Apenrade 1. Januar 1598	1598	23, p. 378	1623	Church order	L	
12	Mandat für die Ämter Trittau und Reinbek über Beichte, Verhalten während des Gottesdienstes sowie Trauung und Taufe fremder Personen 16. Juli 1600	1600	23, p. 385	1625	Mandate / decree	L	

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
13	Befehl an den Propst von Eiderstedt, eine Person ohne vorhergehende öffentliche Kirchenbuße wieder zum Abendmahl zuzulassen 31. Mai 1602	1602	23, p. 387	1626	Mandate / decree	L	
14	Katechismus von Jakob Fabricius d.Ä. 1. Dezember 1602	1602	23, p. 388	1626	Catechism / instruction	L	
15	Zuchtordnung für die Landschaft Nordstrand 10. Februar 1605	1605	23, p. 409	1628	Discipline / police	L	
16a	Mitteilung über den Erlaß eines neuen Predigereides 4. Januar 1607	1607	23, p. 415	1628	Other	L	
16b	Neuer Predigereid [4. Januar 1607]	1607	23, p. 416	1628	Other	L	
17	Revision der Bestallung von Jakob Fabricius zum Generalpropst [4. April 1608]	1608	23, p. 417	1628	Appointment / oath	L	
18	Verfügung gegen die Anhänger des David Joris und andere Täufer in der Landschaft Eiderstedt 10. November 1608	1608	23, p. 420	1628	Discipline / police	L	
19	Predigtmandat 11. April 1609	1609	23, p. 423	1628	Mandate / decree	L	
20	Verbot der Abkündigung weltlicher Sachen durch die Pfarrer 16. August 1610	1610	23, p. 425	1628	Mandate / decree	L	
21	Mandat gegen die Mennoniten und andere Täufer in Eiderstedt 1. Dezember 1614	1614	23, p. 426	1628	Mandate / decree	L	
22	Verordnung zur Predigt und zum Umgang mit umstrittenen Glaubensartikeln 26. Februar 1617	1617	23, p. 429	1628	Confession / doctrine	L	

1.34.2 Land of Dithmarschen

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
1	Abendmahlsordnung [1532]	1532	23, p. 449	1639	Agenda / liturgy	L	
1	Abendmahlsordnung [1532]	1532	23, p. 449	1639	Agenda / liturgy	L	
2	Das „erste Edikt“ - Kirchenzuchtmandat 14. Juli 1537	1537	23, p. 455	1639	Discipline / police	L	
3	Mandat zum Gnadenjahr für die Pfarrwitwen 20. Dezember 1539	1539	23, p. 457	1639	Mandate / decree	L	
4	Landesabschied zu Ehesachen [1539]	1539	23, p. 458	1639	Marriage	L	
5	Das „zweite Edikt“ - Kirchenzuchtmandat 20. März 1540	1540	23, p. 460	1639	Discipline / police	L	

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
6	Fundationsbrief zur Einrichtung einer Schule im Kloster Meldorf 19. Juni 1540	1540	23, p. 464	1639	School / university	L	
7	Landesbeschluß für Prediger und Gemeinden 25. Juni 1541	1541	23, p. 467	1639	Mandate / decree	L	
8	Beschluß zu Eheeinsegnung, Kirchengütern und anderen kirchlichen Belangen 19. Mai 1543	1543	23, p. 468	1639	Marriage	L	
9	Beschlüsse des Meldorf er Kalands 19. April 1547	1547	23, p. 470	1639	Other	L	
10	Bekenntnis der Dithmarscher Kirche zum lutherischen Abendmahl [nach 23. Juni] 1556	1556	23, p. 473	1639	Confession / doctrine	L	
	IIa. Resolution des Rendsburger Rechtstags 3. Oktober 1559	1559	23, p. 477	1639	Mandate / decree	L	
	IIb. Religionsinstruktion 10. November 1559	1559	23, p. 478	1639	Mandate / decree	L	
12	Dithmarscher Landrecht 2. November 1567	1567	23, p. 481	1639	Discipline / police	L	
13a	Visitationsartikel für den Süderdrittenteil 1574/75	1574	23, p. 484	1639	Visitation	L	
13b	Visitationsmandat für den Norderdrittenteil 28. Februar 1575	1575	23, p. 491	1639	Visitation	L	
14	Polizeiordnung für den Norderdrittenteil [um 1579]	1579	23, p. 492	1639	Discipline / police	L	
15	Mandat für den Superintendenten in Norderdithmarschen 12. Juli 1597	1597	23, p. 505	1639	Mandate / decree	L	
16	Mandat zur Superintendenten- und Pfarrerwahl in Norderdithmarschen 5. Juli 1605	1605	23, p. 507	1640	Mandate / decree	L	
17	Mandat über die Pflichten der Superintendenten in Norderdithmarschen 18. Februar 1606	1606	23, p. 510	1641	Mandate / decree	L	

1.35 Volume 24: Transylvania

121 texts.

1.35.1 Principality of Transylvania: diets

- **Tradition**: Multi-confessional diet.
- **Note**: Diet decrees for a principality with several received confessions (Lutheran, Reformed, Unitarian, Catholic).
- **Texts by tradition**: Multi-confessional diet 25, Lutheran 1.

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
1	Thorenburger Landtagsabschied 1552	1552	24, p. 45	1652	Treaty / agreement	T	
2	Klausenburger Landtagsabschied 1556	1556	24, p. 47	1653	Treaty / agreement	T	

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
3	Weißenburger Landtagsabschied 1557	1557	24, p. 50	1654	Treaty / agreement	T	
4	Thorenburger Landtagsabschied 1557	1557	24, p. 52	1654	Treaty / agreement	T	
5	Consensus Doctrinae 1557	1557	24, p. 56	1656	Confession / doctrine	L	
6	Thorenburger Landtagsabschied 1558	1558	24, p. 67	1657	Treaty / agreement	T	
7	Weißenburger Landtagsabschied 1558	1558	24, p. 70	1657	Treaty / agreement	T	
8	Klausenburger Landtagsabschied 1560	1560	24, p. 72	1659	Treaty / agreement	T	
9	Thorenburger Landtagsabschied 1563	1563	24, p. 74	1660	Treaty / agreement	T	
10	Schäßburger Landtagsabschied 1564	1564	24, p. 76	1661	Treaty / agreement	T	
11	Thorenburger Landtagsabschied 1564	1564	24, p. 78	1661	Treaty / agreement	T	
12	Thorenburger Landtagsabschied 1566	1566	24, p. 80	1661	Treaty / agreement	T	
13	Hermannstädter Landtagsabschied 1566	1566	24, p. 82	1661	Treaty / agreement	T	
14	Thorenburger Landtagsabschied 1568	1568	24, p. 84	1661	Treaty / agreement	T	
15	Neumarkter Landtagsabschied 1571	1571	24, p. 86	1661	Treaty / agreement	T	
16	Landesherrliches Druckverbot 1571	1571	24, p. 88	1661	Discipline / police	T	
17	Thorenburger Landtagsabschied 1572	1572	24, p. 89	1662	Treaty / agreement	T	
18	Thorenburger Landtagsabschied 1573	1573	24, p. 91	1662	Treaty / agreement	T	
19	Mediascher Landtagsabschied 1576	1576	24, p. 93	1662	Treaty / agreement	T	
20	Thorenburger Landtagsabschied 1577	1577	24, p. 94	1662	Treaty / agreement	T	
21	Klausenburger Landtagsabschied 1578	1578	24, p. 95	1662	Treaty / agreement	T	
22	Weißenburger Landtagsabschied 1590	1590	24, p. 96	1662	Treaty / agreement	T	
23	Weißenburger Landtagsabschied 1595	1595	24, p. 98	1662	Treaty / agreement	T	
24	Léczfalvaer Landtagsabschied 1600	1600	24, p. 100	1662	Treaty / agreement	T	
25	Mediascher Landtagsabschied 1615	1615	24, p. 102	1662	Treaty / agreement	T	
26	Weißenburger Landtagsabschied 1619	1619	24, p. 104	1663	Treaty / agreement	T	

1.35.2 Transylvanian Saxons

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
1a	Thorenburger Landtagsabschied 1552: Reformationsbüchlein 1543	1543	24, p. 177	1666	Other	L	
1b	Reformationsbüchlein 1543 (deutsche Fassung)	1543	24, p. 191	1666	Other	L	
2	Universitätsbeschluss 1544	1544	24, p. 203	1667	School / university	L	
3	Universitätsbeschluss 1545	1545	24, p. 204	1668	School / university	L	
4a	Kirchenordnung 1547 (lateinische Fassung)	1547	24, p. 206	1668	Church order	L	
4b	Thorenburger Landtagsabschied 1557: Kirchenordnung 1547 (deutsche Fassung)	1547	24, p. 226	1669	Church order	L	
5	Kronstädter Agende 1547	1547	24, p. 247	1670	Agenda / liturgy	L	
6	Kirchenvisitation im Burzenländer Kapitel 1550	1550	24, p. 256	1671	Visitation	L	
7	Universitätsbeschluss 1550	1550	24, p. 258	1672	School / university	L	
8	Burzenländer Artikel 1556	1556	24, p. 259	1673	Other	L	
9	Universitätsbeschlüsse 1557	1557	24, p. 260	1674	School / university	L	
10	Hermannstädter Synodalbeschlüsse 1557	1557	24, p. 261	1675	Consistory / synod / government	L	
11	Bestätigung des Superintendenten 1558	1558	24, p. 264	1676	Consistory / synod / government	L	
12	Bestätigung der Zuständigkeiten der Geistlichkeit 1559	1559	24, p. 265	1677	Other	L	
13a	Zwölf gemeinsame Artikel der Nationsuniversität 1559 (deutsche Fassung)	1559	24, p. 267	1677	School / university	L	
13b	Zwölf gemeinsame Artikel der Nationsuniversität 1560 (lateinische Fassung)	1560	24, p. 269	1677	School / university	L	
14	Anweisungen des Bistritzer Dechanten 1560	1560	24, p. 272	1678	Mandate / decree	L	
15	Vierzehn Artikel auf der gemeinsamen Mediascher Synode 1561	1561	24, p. 274	1679	Consistory / synod / government	L	
16	Hermannstädter Synodalartikel 1562	1562	24, p. 280	1680	Consistory / synod / government	L	
17	Mandat zur Beibehaltung Wittenberger „doctrinam et ritum“ 1563	1563	24, p. 283	1681	Mandate / decree	L	

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
18	Hermannstädter Synodalartikel 1563	1563	24, p. 284	1682	Consistory / synod / government	L	
19a	Disziplinarordnung des Unterwälder Kapitels - Leges Ministrorum 1564	1564	24, p. 287	1682	Articles / statutes	L	
19b	Disziplinarordnung des Unterwälder Kapitels - Ergänzungen 1572	1572	24, p. 289	1682	Consistory / synod / government	L	
20	Hermannstädter Synodalartikel 1565	1565	24, p. 290	1683	Consistory / synod / government	L	
21	Disziplinarartikel für Schullehrer 1565	1565	24, p. 298	1684	School / university	L	
22	Statuten des Bogeschdorfer Kapitels 1566	1566	24, p. 300	1685	Consistory / synod / government	L	
23	Visitationsordnung des Burzenländer Kapitels 1567	1567	24, p. 303	1686	Visitation	L	
24	Gemeinsame Visitationsartikel 1569	1569	24, p. 306	1687	Visitation	L	
25	Spezialartikel des Kapitels von Bulkesch 1569	1569	24, p. 310	1688	Consistory / synod / government	L	
26	Schutzbrief 1571	1571	24, p. 311	1689	Other	L	
27	Statuten des Burzenländer Kapitels 1571	1571	24, p. 313	1690	Consistory / synod / government	L	
28	Universitätsbeschluss 1572	1572	24, p. 319	1691	School / university	L	
29	Landesherrliche Artikel zur Mediascher Synode (Articuli Dionysiani) 1572	1572	24, p. 320	1691	Confession / doctrine	L	
30	Eidformel der Geistlichen 1572	1572	24, p. 323	1691	Other	L	
31	Mandat zur Designation für das Superintendentenamt 1572	1572	24, p. 325	1691	Mandate / decree	L	
32	Burzenländer Zucht-, Ehe- und Erbordnung	n.d.	24, p. 326	1691	Marriage	L	
33	Artikel der Mediascher Synode zu Amtspflichten und Lebenswandel der Pfarrer 1572	1572	24, p. 329	1691	Articles / statutes	L	
34	Bekenntnisformel der Mediascher Synode (Formula pii consensus) 1572	1572	24, p. 331	1691	Confession / doctrine	L	
35	Mandat zur Confessio Augustana 1572	1572	24, p. 357	1691	Mandate / decree	L	
36	Bestätigung und Aufgabenbeschreibung des Superintendenten 1572	1572	24, p. 359	1692	Consistory / synod / government	L	

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
37a	Statuten des Lasselner Kapitels - Dechantenordnung 1572	1572	24, p. 361	1692	Consistory / synod / government	L	
37b	Statuten des Lasselner Kapitels - Statuten für Pfarrer, Niedergeistlichen und Lehrer 1572	1572	24, p. 365	1692	Consistory / synod / government	L	
37c	Statuten des Lasselner Kapitels - Statuten der Lehrer 1606	1606	24, p. 367	1692	Consistory / synod / government	L	
37d	Statuten des Lasselner Kapitels - Ergänzungen für Lehrer und Niedergeistliche 1606	1606	24, p. 369	1693	Consistory / synod / government	L	
38	Beschlüsse des Burzenländer Kapitels 1573	1573	24, p. 370	1693	Consistory / synod / government	L	
39	Statuten des Kisder Kapitels 1573	1573	24, p. 372	1695	Consistory / synod / government	L	
40	Mandat über Ordination, ... 1573	1573	24, p. 378	1696	Mandate / decree	L	
41	Mandat zur Nichtabsetzbarkeit sächs. Pfarrer 1573	1573	24, p. 379	1697	Mandate / decree	L	
42	Visitationsartikel des Zwischenkokelgebietes 1573	1573	24, p. 381	1698	Visitation	L	
43	Disziplinarartikel der Hermannstadter Synode 1574	1574	24, p. 382	1699	Consistory / synod / government	L	
44	Mandat gegen Ehen in verbotenen Graden 1575	1575	24, p. 385	1700	Mandate / decree	L	
45	Synodalbeschlüsse zur Kirchendisziplin 1575	1575	24, p. 386	1701	Consistory / synod / government	L	
46	Mandat zur Zuständigkeit in Ehesachen 1575	1575	24, p. 388	1702	Mandate / decree	L	
47	Ordnung für Niedergeistliche und Schullehrer im Kosder Kapitel 1575	1575	24, p. 389	1703	School / university	L	
48a	Bulkescher Kapitel - bestätigte alte Artikel 1577	1577	24, p. 391	1703	Other	L	
48b	Bulkescher Kapitel - Kapitelstatuten 1577	1577	24, p. 392	1703	Consistory / synod / government	L	
48c	Bulkescher Kapitel Nachtrag 1577	1577	24, p. 395	1703	Other	L	
48d	Bulkescher Kapitel - Ordnung der Schullehrer 1577	1577	24, p. 397	1703	School / university	L	
49	Statuten der Surrogatieverbände von Kosd und Schelken 1577	1577	24, p. 399	1704	Discipline / police	L	
50	Gemeinsame Artikel der Generalkirchenvisitation 1577	1577	24, p. 404	1705	Visitation	L	

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
51	Visitationsordnung des Bulkescher Kapitels 1577	1577	24, p. 412	1706	Visitation	L	
52a	Kirchenvisitation im Bistritzer Kapitel - Mahnung zur christlichen Kirchenzucht 1577	1577	24, p. 417	1706	Visitation	L	
52b	Kirchenvisitation im Bistritzer Kapitel - Visitationsordnung 1577	1577	24, p. 421	1706	Visitation	L	
52c	Kirchenvisitation im Bistritzer Kapitel - Einleitung der Visitationsartikel 1578	1578	24, p. 424	1706	Visitation	L	
53	Artikel der Mediascher Synode 1578	1578	24, p. 426	1707	Articles / statutes	L	
54	Statuten der Kapitel Tekendorf und Groß-Schogen 1578	1578	24, p. 429	1708	Discipline / police	L	
55	Gemeinsame Ordnung für Geistliche und Gemeinde 1578	1578	24, p. 434	1709	Other	L	
56	Burzenländer Visitationsartikel 1578	1578	24, p. 441	1710	Visitation	L	
57	Gemeindestatuten des Burzenländer Kapitels 1580	1580	24, p. 453	1711	Consistory / synod / government	L	
58a	Scholtener Kapitel - allgemeine Kapitelstatuten 1582	1582	24, p. 456	1711	Consistory / synod / government	L	
58b	Scholtener Kapitel - Statuten der Lehrer 1582	1582	24, p. 460	1711	School / university	L	
59	Ordnung der Präsentation von Pfarrern 1582	1582	24, p. 462	1712	Local order	L	
60	Gemeinsame Landesordnung 1587	1587	24, p. 463	1713	Discipline / police	L	
61	Protestation bei Einführung des gregorianischen Kalenders 1590	1590	24, p. 465	1714	Other	L	
62	Mandat über Rechungslegung ... 1592	1592	24, p. 466	1715	Mandate / decree	L	
63	Schäßburger Synodalartikel 1593	1593	24, p. 468	1716	Consistory / synod / government	L	
64	Ordnung der Synoden 1593	1593	24, p. 469	1717	Consistory / synod / government	L	
65	Mandat über Zuständigkeit in Ehesachen 1593	1593	24, p. 470	1718	Mandate / decree	L	
66	Statuten des Hermannstädter Kapitels 1594	1594	24, p. 471	1719	Consistory / synod / government	L	
67	Ordnung der Niedergeistlichen und Lehrer im Hermannstadter Kapitel 1594	1594	24, p. 476	1720	Local order	L	

No.	Order	Date	Sehling	Doc	Kind	Trad.	Interim / notes
68	Mediascher Synodalartikel gegen Zauberei 1595	1595	24, p. 478	1721	Consistory / synod / government	L	
69	Ordnung der Superintendentenwahl 1601	1601	24, p. 479	1722	Consistory / synod / government	L	
70	Ordnung der Niedergeistlichen und Lehrer im Schelker Kapitel 1603	1603	24, p. 481	1723	Local order	L	
71	Mediascher Synodalartikel 1605	1605	24, p. 483	1724	Consistory / synod / government	L	
72	Mediascher Synodalartikel 1607	1607	24, p. 485	1725	Consistory / synod / government	L	
73	Articuli de ceremoniis 1607	1607	24, p. 488	1726	Confession / doctrine	L	
74	Synodale Ordnung für Niedergeistliche 1607	1607	24, p. 495	1727	Consistory / synod / government	L	
75	Gemeinsame Erweiterung der Artikel zur Generalkirchenvisitation 1607	1607	24, p. 497	1728	Visitation	L	
76	Mediascher Synodalartikel 1615	1615	24, p. 500	1729	Consistory / synod / government	L	
77	Mandat zur Generalkirchenvisitation 1615	1615	24, p. 507	1730	Mandate / decree	L	
78	Publikationsverbot 1615	1615	24, p. 508	1731	Other	L	
79	Mandat der Nationsuniversität 1615	1615	24, p. 509	1732	Mandate / decree	L	
80	Gemeinsame Ordnung der Pfarrerwahl 1615	1615	24, p. 511	1733	Other	L	
81	Visitationsfragen des Hermannstädter Rates 1617	1617	24, p. 512	1734	Visitation	L	
82	Eheordnung 1620	1620	24, p. 514	1735	Marriage	L	

Chapter 2. The Order of the Mass

This chapter compares the **order of the Mass** (*ordo missae*, *Ordnung des Amts*, *Ordnung des Nachtmahls*) in the evangelical church orders printed in Emil Sehling's *Die evangelischen Kirchenordnungen des XVI. Jahrhunderts* (The Evangelical Church Orders of the Sixteenth Century). Other chapters of this book treat the parts of the Mass one by one. This chapter puts them back together. It asks:

- **The whole ordo.** What sequence of parts did each order prescribe, from the opening to the dismissal? Which orders kept the shape of the Roman Mass, and which built a new service around the sermon?
- **Families.** Which orders copied which? Where do the main types of evangelical Mass come from?
- **The ordinaries.** What happened to the fixed parts (the Kyrie, Gloria, Creed, Sanctus and Agnus Dei), and to the fixed dialogues and formulas around them (the salutation, the Preface dialogue, the Pax, the *Ite missa est* [Go, it is the dismissal])? In particular:
  - Was the Kyrie sung three, four or nine times? Were the old seasonal Kyrie chants kept?
  - Who intoned the Gloria and the Creed? Which creed was sung?
  - Was the Sanctus sung with or without the Benedictus, and where did it fall?
  - How many times was the Agnus Dei sung, and how did it end?
  - What took the place of the *Ite missa est*?
- **The service without communicants.** What remained of the Mass when nobody came to the Lord's Table?

How the chapter is laid out.

- §2.1 summarizes the findings, and §2.2 sets out the scope, the method and what was not found.
- §2.3 sets the baselines: the Roman ordo, and Luther's *Formula missae* (1523) and *Deutsche Messe* (1526).
- §2.4 describes the families of evangelical ordo, and §2.5 compares them in a table.
- §§2.6–2.13 take the ordinaries and fixed formulas in order: Kyrie (§2.6), Gloria (§2.7), salutation, collect and Pax (§2.8), Creed (§2.9), Preface and Sanctus (§2.10), the Lord's Prayer and the Words of Institution (§2.11), Agnus Dei (§2.12), and the dismissal and blessing (§2.13).
- §2.14 deals with the Sunday service when nobody communicated.
- §2.15 gathers the ceremonial: the sign of the cross, kneeling, bowing, hats, hands, turning, places at the altar, the kiss of peace and incense.
- §2.16 is a concordance of the orders quoted.

Related chapters. This chapter refers to the others constantly. They hold the detail:

- the opening versicles, the confession and absolution, and the exhortation to communicants: Chapter 3;
- the introit, the lessons, the gradual, alleluia and sequence, the offertory, the Proper Prefaces and the communion chant: Chapter 4;
- the collect, the secret and the postcommunion: Chapter 5;
- the hymns sung in each slot, including the German, troped and paraphrased ordinaries ("Allein Gott", "Wir glauben all", "Jesaia dem Propheten", "Christe du Lamm Gottes"): Chapter 8, §§8.6–8.15;
- the canon, the Words of Institution and the elevation, order by order, in the early German Masses and their successors: Chapter 7;
- the sermon, its place and its length: Chapter 11;
- the general prayer of the church: Chapter 6;
- the Litany and the bidding prayers at the Mass: Chapter 13, §13.21;
- the organ in alternation with the choir: Chapter 9, §9.3;
- vestments, lights and the elevation as marks of the feast: Chapter 14 and Chapter 12, §12.10.

2.1 Summary of findings

1. Two baselines, not one (§2.3). Luther left two Masses, and the orders descend from both.

- **The *Formula missae* (1523)**: the Latin Mass with the offertory and canon cut and the Words of Institution sung in the Preface; the ordinaries kept "with various melodies for the various seasons"; *Benedicamus* for *Ite missa est* (Go, it is the dismissal).

- **The *Deutsche Messe* (1526)**: German hymns for the introit and the chants; the Kyrie three times "and not nine"; no Gloria; a paraphrase of the Lord's Prayer and an exhortation for the Preface; the bread and cup given separately after their words.

2. Seven families of ordo (§2.4).

- **Saxon** (Wittenberg 1533, Saxony 1539, 1580): the Latin school Mass with German pieces grafted on; Preface only on feasts or not at all.
- **Bugenhagen's northern Mass** (Braunschweig 1528 to Mecklenburg 1552): Latin and German side by side; Preface, Sanctus and exhortation optional; "after the Amen nothing more is sung".
- **Franconian** (Nürnberg 1533, Hof 1592): no Preface; the epistle and gospel read as chapters in course; **the Sanctus after the Words of Institution**, then the Lord's Prayer and the Pax.
- **Prussian** (1525): the Words of Institution sung in the Preface; Kyrie in three tongues; Agnus Dei twice.
- **The Latin frame** (Brandenburg 1540, Pfalz-Neuburg 1543, the Palatinate 1546, Breslau 1557): Preface dialogue, Pax and threefold Agnus kept; Breslau even kept *Ite missa est*.
- **Upper German** (Württemberg 1553, Strasbourg 1598, both Lutheran): the sermon service with the Supper added; no Kyrie, Gloria, Preface, Sanctus or Agnus.
- **Reformed** (Palatinate 1563, Bentheim-Tecklenburg 1588, both Reformed): the Supper form read at the table, the Apostles' Creed, the breaking of bread.

3. Kyrie: three, four or nine; never seven (§2.6.1). Luther's "three times and not nine" became the parish norm. Nine survived for feasts and choirs (Wittenberg 1533; Pomerania 1542). A fourfold Kyrie (Kyrie, Christe, Kyrie, Kyrie) comes from Müntzer (1524, Radical Reformation) and survives in Calenberg-Göttingen 1542 and the Hessian *Agende* of 1574 (Philippist). Braunschweig-Wolfenbüttel (1543) allows "three times, four times or nine times" in figured music "at the schoolmaster's pleasure", but three plainly "in the name of the Father and of the Son and of the Holy Ghost". No sevenfold Kyrie is found.

4. The seasonal Kyrie chants survived (§2.6.2). The orders with Latin schools kept the medieval cycle by name: *dominicale* (Sunday [Kyrie]), *angelicum* (angelic [Kyrie]), *paschale* (Easter [Kyrie]), *Fons bonitatis* (Fount of goodness), *Magne Deus* (Great God), *summum* (the highest [chant]), *minus summum* (the lesser summum), *apostolicum* (apostles' [Kyrie]), *de martyribus* (of martyrs), *de virginibus* (of virgins; Buxtehude 1565; Pomerania 1542; Nördlingen 1544; Pfalz-Zweibrücken 1557; Hof 1592, with the matching Gloria, Sanctus and Agnus "of the season").

5. Gloria: the festal companion of the Kyrie (§2.7). Not after "the plain Kyrie" (Wittenberg 1533); "at times and not always" (Pomerania 1535). Where kept, the priest intoned, the scholars sang *Et in terra* (And on earth) "and no more", the people sang "Allein Gott" (To God alone), and the scholars and organ finished the Latin (Braunschweig-Wolfenbüttel 1543).

6. Creed: three layers, and two creeds (§2.9). The priest intoned *Credo in unum Deum* (I believe in one God), the scholars sang the Latin *Patrem* (the Nicene Creed), and the people "Wir glauben all" (We all believe; Wittenberg 1533 and most Saxon and northern orders). Prussia (1525) forbade the priest's intonation. Which creed (§2.9.4):

- **Nicene only**: the Saxon, Bugenhagen and Franconian orders, in Latin, in German verse by verse (Braunschweig 1528, Hamburg 1529), or as "Wir glauben" (We believe).
- **Apostles' only**:
  - Strasbourg 1524 (Moderate Reformed), sung after the sermon, "the great *Patrem* … sung by some";
  - the Goslar foundation 1534;
  - the Upper German pulpit (Württemberg 1553);
    - the Reformed Supper (Frankfurt's French church 1554 and the Palatinate 1563, both Reformed).
- **A free choice**: Hesse 1574 (Philippist; the Apostles' Creed, Luther's paraphrase, or the Nicene); Kurland 1570.
- **By occasion**:
  - Hesse 1566 (Moderate Reformed): the Apostles' Creed every Sunday, the Nicene or Athanasian on the feasts of Christ;
  - Rothenberg 1618: "Wir glauben" on Sundays, the Apostles' Creed on other feasts;
  - Prussia 1568 and Feuchtwangen 1563: the Latin Nicene and the German creed on alternate Sundays.

7. The Preface was optional; the Sanctus moved (§2.10). The Preface was required in only a few orders, festal or optional in most, absent in the *Deutsche Messe* (German Mass), Nürnberg, Albertine Saxony 1580 and Württemberg. The Sanctus stood in five places: before the Verba, after the Verba with or without a Preface, during the distribution, or nowhere. The Latin Sanctus

kept its *Benedictus*; Luther's "Jesaia dem Propheten" (To Isaiah the prophet) lost it; the Braunschweig-Wolfenbüttel Trinitarian Sanctus kept it with the Hebrew *Hosianna* (Hosanna).

8. The Lord's Prayer and the Verba in seven sequences (§2.11): the Lord's Prayer before the Verba, after them, paraphrased in the exhortation, sung as a hymn before the confession, or said inside a prayer before the creed. The bread and cup were given separately after their own words in the *Deutsche Messe*, Prussia 1544 and the Saxon villages.

9. Agnus Dei: three, two or one (§2.12). Three, as of old (Brandenburg 1540; Regensburg; Luther's German "Christe du Lamm Gottes" [Christ, thou Lamb of God] with "Give us thy peace" the third time). **Two** in Prussia 1525 and Livonia 1533, "for brevity's sake", the first ending *miserere nobis* (have mercy upon us) and the second *dona nobis pacem* (grant us peace). **Once** in the Albertine *Cellische Ordnungen* (1545). It stood before, during or after the distribution.

10. No *Ite missa est*; Benedicamus or nothing; Aaronic, Trinitarian or both (§2.13).

- **The *Ite missa est***: kept only at Breslau (1557, beside the *Benedicamus*) and in the Ansbach visitation of 1536.
- **The *Benedicamus***, in its place:
    - in Latin, in the *Formula missae* (Form of the Mass) and the Franconian, Pfalz-Neuburg, Regensburg, Hohenlohe, Henneberg and Transylvanian orders;
        - in German, in the early German Masses (Müntzer (Radical Reformation), Erfurt, Lippe, Worms and Strasbourg (both Moderate Reformed)) and at Hof in 1592.
- **Neither**: the *Deutsche Messe* and most Saxon, Bugenhagen and Upper German orders end with the collect and the blessing.
- **The blessing**:
    - the Aaronic blessing is the rule;
        - Worms and Strasbourg (1524, both Moderate Reformed) and Regensburg (1542) used a Trinitarian blessing alone;
        - Strasbourg (1524, Moderate Reformed) put both together;
    - Brandenburg-Nürnberg (1533) offered four forms (Numbers 6, Psalm 67 and two Trinitarian), a set copied by a dozen orders;
    - Prussia (1525) sang Psalm 67 on feasts and the Aaronic blessing on ordinary days;
    - Strasbourg (1598) closed the sermon with the Trinitarian blessing and the Supper with both.

11. Without communicants, no Mass (§2.14). The service stopped after the sermon with a psalm, a collect and the blessing (Pomerania 1535; Mecklenburg 1552; Saxony 1580), or fell back to an office of psalm, chapter, creed and suffrages (Transylvania 1547). Hof kept a Mass-shaped daily service for its schoolboys, with the Kyrie, Sanctus and Agnus of the season and no communion.

12. Few rubrics, and kneeling the chief gesture (§2.15).

- **Sign of the cross.** It was still printed in the early German Masses: over bread and cup at Allstedt 1523 (Müntzer, Radical Reformation), and at the greeting and the blessing at Strasbourg 1524 (Moderate Reformed). Hof printed it at the Pax and the blessing in 1592. Elsewhere it was let go: "so many crosses" at Hannover 1536, and "without all papistical crossing" at Danzig 1557.
- **Kneeling, never genuflection.** No order knows the Roman genuflection. The priest kneels at the preparation and after communion. The people kneel at the Kyrie (Schwäbisch Hall 1527), at the Lord's Prayer before the Verba (Hall 1535) and at the thanksgiving. Communicants kneel at the altar. The Polish synods of the Sandomierz consensus (1578, 1583) allowed standing or kneeling but forbade sitting. Calvinizing Nassau (1575, Philippist) warned against "folded hands and bending of the knee" as to an idol.
- **Other gestures.**
    - Bows survive only in the Latin canons (Brandenburg 1540).
        - Men are bareheaded and women covered (Hesse 1566, Moderate Reformed).
    - Nothing is said of the celebrant's hands beyond what they hold.
    - The minister turns to the altar to pray and to the people to read, greet and exhort. Döber (1525) said everything toward the people.
- **Not found.** No epistle or gospel horn, no turn over the right shoulder, no *orans* or joined hands, no kiss of altar, book or deacon, no biretta rubric, no incense and no *Lavabo*. Strasbourg (1542, Moderate Reformed) replaced the kiss of peace

with a reading on reconciliation.

2.2 Scope, sources and method

2.2.1 Sources and searches

The chapter draws on the full text of the Sehling edition in `eko.db`. Two searches were made:

- **Full ordos.** Every passage was found in which, within about 5,000 characters, the order names at least thirteen of the parts of the Mass (introit, Kyrie, Gloria, collect, epistle, gradual or sequence, gospel, creed, sermon, exhortation, Preface, Sanctus, Lord's Prayer, Words of Institution, Agnus Dei, distribution, thanksgiving, blessing). These passages, about forty in all, were read in full, and the representative ones are compared in §§2.4–2.5.
- **The ordinaries.** The corpus was searched for:
  - the Kyrie near the words for numbers (*drei*, *dreimal*, *neun*, *vier*, *sieben*, *ter*, *novies*, *semel*, *einmal*), and for runs of printed acclamations, which were counted;
  - the named Kyrie chants (*dominicale*, *angelicum*, *paschale*, *Fons bonitatis*, *Magne Deus*, *summum*, *apostolicum*, *de martyribus* and the rest);
  - the Agnus Dei near the same number words and near *dona nobis pacem* (grant us peace), *miserere nobis* (have mercy upon us), *gib uns deinen Frieden* (give us thy peace);
  - *Benedictus qui venit* (Blessed is he that cometh), *Osanna* (Hosanna), *Hosianna* (Hosanna);
  - *Ite missa est* (Go, it is the dismissal), *Benedicamus*;
  - *symbolum apostolicum* (Apostles' Creed), *Nicenum* (Nicene [Creed]), *Athanasii* (Athanasius's [creed]) near the Mass and its parts.

Pages were checked against Sehling's running heads, which often correct the database's record headings. One attribution was corrected in the course of the work: the Breslau account of the Sunday Mass and of the hours of the Passion is a report of 1557, not an order of 1550 (Sehling 3, pp. 404–405), and Chapter 10 has been amended accordingly.

2.2.2 What was not found

- **No sevenfold Kyrie.** The counts in the corpus are three, four and nine (§2.6.1). No order prescribes seven or six acclamations.
- **No order that kept the offertory or the canon** as the priest's prayer of sacrifice. What the Latin-frame orders kept is described in Chapter 7.
- **No evangelical Mass without communicants** (§2.14), except the Hof schoolboys' daily exercise, which has no consecration.
- **No fixed Lutheran ordo.** Even within a family the orders allow the minister to drop the Gloria, the Preface, the Sanctus or the exhortation "when it will grow too long". The tables give the full form each order prescribes; few churches will have sung all of it every Sunday.

2.3 The baselines: the Roman ordo and Luther's two Masses

2.3.1 The Roman ordo in outline

What the reformers inherited. The orders measure themselves against the late medieval Roman Mass, which they call *die messe* (the Mass), *das ampt* (the office) or *die hohe messe* (the high Mass). In outline it ran:

1. the priest's preparation at the altar (*Introibo*, Psalm 43, *Confiteor*);
2. introit, Kyrie (nine acclamations), Gloria;
3. salutation and collect(s);
4. epistle, gradual, alleluia or tract, sequence;
5. gospel, Nicene Creed (intoned by the priest, continued by the choir);
6. offertory and offertory prayers, the secret;
7. Preface dialogue (*Dominus vobiscum*, *Sursum corda*, *Gratias agamus*), Preface, Sanctus with Benedictus;
8. the canon, with the Words of Institution said silently and the elevation;

9. Lord's Prayer with its introduction (*Praeceptis salutaribus*) and embolism (*Libera nos*), the fraction, the Pax ("The peace of the Lord be always with you"), Agnus Dei (three times, the third ending *dona nobis pacem* [grant us peace]);
10. communion, communion chant, postcommunion;
11. *Ite missa est* (Go, it is the dismissal; or *Benedicamus Domino* [Let us bless the Lord] when there was no Gloria), blessing.

The sermon had no fixed place in the Roman Mass. Every evangelical order gave it one.

2.3.2 *Formula missae*, 1523: the Latin Mass purged

Keep the ordinaries, cut the sacrifice. Luther's Latin order of 1523 kept almost everything before the creed "because it is ours and free". It cut the offertory and the canon, and moved the Words of Institution into the Preface. The ordinaries stayed, sung by the choir "with various melodies for the various seasons". **Wittenberg, Luther, *Formula missae*, 1523** (Sehling 1, p. 5):

Secondly, the Kyrie eleison, as it hath been celebrated hitherto, with various melodies for the various seasons, we embrace, together with the angelic hymn following, *Gloria in excelsis*; yet it shall stand in the bishop's judgment how often he will have it left out.

The rest of the order is described in Chapter 7, §7.3. In outline (Sehling 1, pp. 5–6):

- introit, Kyrie, Gloria, one collect, epistle;
- a gradual of two verses with the alleluia; no sequences but *Grates nunc omnes* (Let us all now give thanks), *Sancti Spiritus* and *Veni sancte Spiritus* (Come, Holy Spirit), at the bishop's pleasure;
- gospel, the Nicene Creed ("not displeasing" if sung, but at the bishop's choice), and the sermon either after the creed or before the introit;
- the preparation of bread and wine "during the creed or after", in the accustomed manner;
- *Dominus vobiscum* (The Lord be with you), *Sursum corda* (Lift up your hearts), the Preface, and the Words of Institution sung in the Preface tone;
- the Sanctus, with the elevation during the Benedictus;
- the Lord's Prayer, without the *Libera nos* (Deliver us), the fraction or the commixture, then at once *Pax Domini* (The peace of the Lord), "a kind of public absolution";
- the communion during the Agnus Dei; the postcommunion *Quod ore sumpsimus* (What we have taken with our mouth) or *Corpus tuum* (Thy body);
- *Benedicamus Domino* (Let us bless the Lord) for *Ite missa est* (Go, it is the dismissal), and the blessing.

The last item is Luther's replacement for the dismissal. **Wittenberg, Luther, *Formula missae*, 1523** (Sehling 1, p. 6):

In the place of *Ite missa* let *Benedicamus Domino* be said, with alleluia added (where and when it pleaseth) in its melodies; or let the *Benedicamus* be borrowed from Vespers. Eighthly, let the accustomed blessing be given. Or let that of Numbers 6 be taken, which the Lord himself set in order, saying: "The Lord bless us and keep us, the Lord show us his face and have mercy upon us, the Lord turn his face unto us and give us peace." Or that of Psalm 96 [67]: "God, even our own God, shall bless us; God shall bless us, and all the ends of the earth shall fear him. Amen."

2.3.3 *Deutsche Messe*, 1526: the German Mass for the people

Three Kyries, German hymns, the Verba with the distribution. The *Deutsche Messe* (German Mass) made a different shape, for the parishes. A German psalm or hymn stood for the introit; the Kyrie was cut to three acclamations; the Gloria was gone; a German hymn followed the epistle and "Wir glauben all" (We all believe) the gospel; the Preface was replaced by a paraphrase of the Lord's Prayer and an exhortation; the Words of Institution were sung, the bread given after the words over the bread and the cup after the words over the cup, with German hymns during each; and the service ended with a collect and the Aaronic blessing (Sehling 1, pp. 14–16). Of the Kyrie it says. **Wittenberg, Luther, *Deutsche Messe und ordnung gottis diensts*, 1526** (Sehling 1, p. 14):

Thereupon the Kyrie eleison, also in the same tone, three times and not nine times, as followeth: Kyrie eleison.

The German Sanctus "Jesaia dem Propheten" (To Isaiah the prophet) and "Christe du Lamm Gottes" (Christ, thou Lamb of God) belong to the distribution and its close (§§2.10, 2.12; Chapter 8, §§8.12, 8.15).

2.3.4 The three side by side

Part	Roman Mass	*Formula missae* 1523	*Deutsche Messe* 1526
Opening	*Introibo* (I will go in), *Confiteor* (I confess)	(priest's private preparation, unregulated)	—
Introit	Latin antiphon and psalm	Latin, Sunday and feast introits	German psalm or hymn
Kyrie	ninefold, seasonal chant	"various melodies for various seasons"	threefold, "not nine times"
Gloria	Sundays and feasts	kept; bishop may omit	omitted
Collect	one or more	one only	one, in German
Epistle	sung	sung	read facing the people
Between the readings	gradual, alleluia, tract, sequence	gradual of two verses, alleluia; few sequences	German hymn
Gospel	sung	sung	read facing the people
Creed	Nicene, Latin	Nicene, at the bishop's choice	"Wir glauben all" (We all believe)
Sermon	—	after the creed or before the introit	after the creed
Offertory, secret	yes	cut	cut
Preface	yes	yes, with the Verba in the Preface tone	replaced by paraphrase of the Lord's Prayer and exhortation
Sanctus	with Benedictus, before the canon	after the Verba, elevation during Benedictus	German Sanctus during the distribution
Canon	yes	cut	cut
Lord's Prayer	after the canon	after the Sanctus	paraphrased before the Verba
Pax	before the Agnus	after the Lord's Prayer, as absolution	—
Agnus Dei	three times, before communion	during communion	German Agnus after the cup
Postcommunion	yes	*Quod ore* (What with our mouth) or *Corpus tuum* (Thy body)	German collect
Dismissal	*Ite missa est* (Go, it is the dismissal)	*Benedicamus Domino* (Let us bless the Lord)	—
Blessing	yes	usual, or Num 6, or Ps 67	Num 6

2.4 The families of evangelical ordo

Seven shapes. The orders fall into families. Within each, later orders copy earlier ones, often word for word. The families differ less in what they cut than in where they put what they kept: the sermon, the Preface and Sanctus, the Lord's Prayer and the Words of Institution.

2.4.1 The Saxon Mass: Latin and German together

Wittenberg and the Albertine orders. The Wittenberg town order of 1533, Duke Henry's order of 1539 and the Albertine *Kirchenordnung* (church order) of 1580 keep the Latin Mass of the *Formula missae* (Form of the Mass) for the school and graft the German pieces of the *Deutsche Messe* (German Mass) on to it. The common pattern:

- introit (Latin, or a German psalm), Kyrie, Gloria with the Latin *Et in terra* (And on earth);
- a German collect, the epistle sung or read in German facing the people;
- an alleluia, sequence or German hymn;
- the gospel in German; the priest intones *Credo in unum Deum* (I believe in one God), the scholars sing the Latin *Patrem* (the Nicene Creed), and the people "Wir glauben all" (We all believe);
- the sermon; then, for the communicants, the paraphrase of the Lord's Prayer and the exhortation from the *Deutsche Messe* (Saxony 1539, 1580), or the Lord's Prayer sung (Wittenberg 1533);
- the Words of Institution sung in German;
- the distribution, with the Latin Agnus Dei and the German Sanctus, "Jesus Christus unser Heiland" (Jesus Christ our Saviour), "Gott sei gelobet" (God be praised) and Psalm 111;
- "Christe du Lamm Gottes" (Christ, thou Lamb of God), a German collect, the Aaronic blessing.

The Preface survives here only for the feasts. At Wittenberg "the Preface may well often be left out, that we may the more diligently attend to the Lord's Supper, for that alone is the matter" (Sehling 1, p. 704). Duke Henry's order allows a Latin Preface "on the feasts, and now and then on Sundays" (Sehling 1, p. 274). The Albertine order of 1580 has none (Sehling 1, pp. 368–369). On the Saxon Kyrie and Creed see §§2.6, 2.9.

2.4.2 Bugenhagen's northern Mass

Braunschweig, Hamburg, Lübeck, Pomerania, Braunschweig-Wolfenbüttel, Mecklenburg. Bugenhagen's orders (Braunschweig 1528, Hamburg 1529, Lübeck 1531, Pomerania 1535, Denmark 1537, Schleswig-Holstein 1542, Braunschweig-Wolfenbüttel 1543) and the Mecklenburg order of 1552 make the Mass of the northern towns. Its marks:

- a confession and absolution, or a prayer at the altar, before the introit (Mecklenburg 1552, Braunschweig-Wolfenbüttel 1543: Chapter 3, §3.4);
- Kyrie and Gloria in Latin or German, the Gloria "at times and not always" (Pomerania 1535);
- the creed intoned by the priest, the Latin *Patrem* (the Nicene Creed) sung "*dominicaliter*, in full", then "Wir glauben" (We believe; Pomerania 1535, Braunschweig-Wolfenbüttel 1543, Mecklenburg 1552);
- the sermon, with the general prayer at its end;
- a Preface and Sanctus that are allowed but not required;
- the exhortation to the communicants, the Lord's Prayer and the Words of Institution sung together;
- the distribution with "O Lamm Gottes" (O Lamb of God), "Jesus Christus" (Jesus Christ [our Saviour]), "Gott sei gelobet" (God be praised) or Psalm 111; "Christe du Lamm Gottes" (Christ, thou Lamb of God) after it; a collect and the Aaronic blessing.

The Pomeranian order puts the Preface, the Sanctus and the exhortation at the minister's discretion, and allows him to go straight from the sermon hymn to the Lord's Prayer "as is also done at Wittenberg". **Pomerania, *Kirchenordnung*, 1535** (Sehling 4, p. 341):

Then the Preface is sung in Latin, but not always, rather when one will, especially at the high feasts, with the Sanctus in Latin or German; and thereafter the exhortation concerning the sacrament is read, briefly. Long singing, wherein some priests have pleasure, shall for this cause be avoided: that such Christian and wholesome ceremonies may remain pleasant to the people and not grow wearisome, and that the people also be exhorted to remain there gladly until the last benediction or blessing. Therefore, when the people after the sermon have sung the German song, the priest may at times and often let all the rest stand over, even the exhortation or confession, that this be not too long and wearisome, and begin straightway: Let us pray, Our Father, etc., as is also kept at Wittenberg.

The Mecklenburg order of 1552 is the fullest of the family, and gives the Latin text and notes of the creed and the Preface (§§2.9, 2.10).

2.4.3 The Franconian Mass: Nürnberg and Brandenburg-Ansbach

A Mass without a Preface. The Brandenburg-Nürnberg order of 1533 and its descendants (the Nürnberg agendas, Hof 1592) keep the Latin ordinaries for the schools but make the communion its own action, "the order of the Lord's Supper", after the sermon. Its marks:

- the priest says a *Confiteor* (I confess) privately and reads the introit, the Kyrie and the *Et in terra* (And on earth), which the scholars sing in Latin or the people in German;
- *Dominus vobiscum* (The Lord be with you) and one or more German collects;
- the epistle and gospel read as chapters in course, "the first chapter of the epistle to the Romans" and so on, not the Sunday pericopes (Chapter 4, §4.5);
- the Credo sung in Latin by the scholars, or "Wir glauben" (We believe) by the people; the sermon;
- no Preface: the exhortation, then the Words of Institution sung;
- **the Sanctus after the Words of Institution**, then the Lord's Prayer with its old Latin introduction, and the Pax;
- the distribution during the Agnus Dei; collect; *Benedicamus*; one of several blessings.

Brandenburg-Nürnberg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1533 (Sehling 11, pp. 196–197):

Thereafter followeth the Sanctus in Latin or German. Thereupon straightway: *Oremus, praeceptis salutaribus moniti et divina institutione formati, audemus dicere: Pater noster.* (Let us pray. Taught by saving precepts and formed by divine institution, we make bold to say: Our Father.) […] Thereafter straightway: *Pax Domini sit semper vobiscum* (The peace of the Lord be always with you), etc., or else in German, as it is noted hereafter.

The order of Hof (1592) keeps the Franconian shape, but moves the Lord's Prayer and the Pax before the Words of Institution, and sings the Sanctus and Agnus Dei of the season during the distribution (Sehling 11, pp. 425–426).

2.4.4 The Prussian Mass of 1525: the Words of Institution in the Preface

The *Formula missae* in German. The Prussian articles of 1525 follow the *Formula missae* (Form of the Mass) in setting the Words of Institution inside the Preface, sung in German, with the elevation, the Sanctus after it, and the Pax as an absolution. They add three peculiarities: the Kyrie sung in Greek, Latin and German, the creed not intoned by the priest, and the Agnus Dei sung only twice (§§2.6, 2.9, 2.12). **Prussia, *Artikel der ceremonien und anderer kirchen ordnung*, 1525** (Sehling 4, p. 32):

Then followeth the Preface, which the priest singeth in German, together with the evangelical words of the blessing or consecration of bread and wine (for the offertory, the secret, the lesser and greater canon are of necessity left out). When the Preface and consecration are ended, a sign is given with the bell; then straightway the priest elevateth both parts of the sacrament, one after the other, without delay. Meanwhile, and as soon as the Preface together with the evangelical benediction is ended, the choir singeth the Sanctus in German or Latin as occasion serveth, with few notes.

The Livonian towns took over the Prussian order at Wolmar in 1533 (Sehling 5, pp. 15–16).

2.4.5 The Mass that kept the Latin frame

Brandenburg, Pfalz-Neuburg, the Palatinate before 1556. A group of orders of the 1540s kept more of the Latin Mass than Wittenberg did: the Preface dialogue, the Pax, the Agnus Dei three times, even the old prayers before communion. The Brandenburg order of 1540 and the Pfalz-Neuburg order of 1543 are treated in Chapter 7, §§7.12, 7.14. The provisional order of the Palatinate (1546, Lutheran; not an Interim order) even kept the tail of the secret, *per omnia saecula* (world without end), before the Preface dialogue. **Palatinate, *Gemaine maß, die kirchen- und gottesdinst anzurichten*, 1546** (Sehling 14, pp. 96–97):

After the sermon there shall be made an exhortation to the communicants out of Duke Ottheinrich's church order, or the like, before the altar; and then [the priest] beginneth to sing: *Per omnia saecula* (World without end); the choir: *Amen*; the priest: *Dominus vobiscum* (The Lord be with you); the choir: *Et cum spiritu tuo* (And with thy spirit); the priest: *Sursum corda* (Lift up your hearts); the choir: *Habemus ad Dominum* (We lift them up unto the Lord); the priest: *Gratias agamus Domino Deo nostro* (Let us give thanks unto the Lord our God); the choir: *Dignum et iustum est* (It is meet and right); the priest: *Vere dignum et iustum est* (It is very meet and right), etc. And on the high feasts the priest singeth the whole Preface, and the choir thereafter the Sanctus as far as the Agnus Dei; thereafter the priest beginneth to sing in German the Our Father in the common tone.

The Breslau churches went further still. A report of 1557 says that the Sunday high Mass was sung by a chaplain "in his habit, as of old", through the gospel and the *Patrem* (the Nicene Creed); then came the sermon; "the sermon ended, the chaplain singeth the Preface; after the sermon he elevateth the sacrament"; and the Mass closed with the Sanctus, Agnus Dei and communion chant, the postcommunion, "and with the *Benedicamus* or *Ite missa est*" (Sehling 3, p. 404).

2.4.6 The Upper German preaching service with communion

Württemberg, Baden, Strasbourg and their neighbours. These are Lutheran orders: "Upper German" here names the south-western shape of service, not the Moderate Reformed tradition. The Württemberg order of 1553 (and its copies in Baden 1556, Mömpelgard 1560 and the Palatinate of 1556) has no introit, Kyrie, Gloria, epistle, Preface, Sanctus or Agnus Dei. The service is the sermon service of every Sunday, to which the communion is added:

1. a German hymn ("Komm heiliger Geist", "Nun bitten wir" or a psalm "agreeable to the season");
2. the sermon, which on communion days includes "a short instruction" on the Supper;
3. the creed sung in German;
4. the exhortation to the communicants, read at the altar;
5. the general prayer, then "the church shall sing the Our Father in German together";
6. the public confession and absolution;
7. the Words of Institution read "with loud, understandable voice";
8. the distribution, with "Gott sei gelobet" (God be praised), "Jesus Christus unser Heiland" (Jesus Christ our Saviour) or another hymn;
9. a thanksgiving prayer and the blessing, in one of three forms.

(Sehling 16, pp. 252–255.) The opening rubric is quoted in Chapter 8, §8.3.4. Strasbourg in 1598 keeps the same shape: the ordinary Sunday service "until the hymn after the sermon"; then the pastor goes to the altar while the church sings the German *Grates nunc omnes* (Let us all now give thanks), and reads the Württemberg exhortation (Sehling 20/1, pp. 611–612).

2.4.7 The Reformed Supper

The Palatinate after 1563. The Palatine order of 1563 (Reformed), and the Reformed orders that copied it (Bentheim-Tecklenburg 1588, Ysenburg-Birstein 1598), keep nothing of the ordinaries. After the sermon on the Supper and the Sunday prayer, the minister reads at the table the "Form for holding the holy Supper":

- the Words of Institution from 1 Corinthians 11, with the self-examination and the list of those excluded;
- the doctrine of the Supper; a prayer ending in the Lord's Prayer;
- the Apostles' Creed, "with mouth and heart";
- a lifting up of hearts "into heaven, where Christ Jesus is", in place of the *Sursum corda* (Lift up your hearts);
- the breaking of the bread with the words of 1 Corinthians 10:16;
- singing, or the reading of John 14–18 or Isaiah 53, during the distribution;
- a thanksgiving from Psalm 103 and a closing prayer. Bentheim-Tecklenburg (Reformed) adds: "After all this the psalm is sung, and thereafter the blessing of the Lord spoken" (Sehling 22, p. 275).

The breaking replaced the distribution formula. **Palatinate, *Kirchenordnung*, 1563** (Reformed; Sehling 14, p. 386):

Here shall the minister of the church break of the bread of the Lord to every one, and in giving it say: The bread which we break is the communion of the body of Christ. And the other minister of the church, in giving the cup, [shall] say: The cup of thanksgiving, wherewith we give thanks, is the communion of the blood of Christ.

The Bentheim-Tecklenburg order of 1588 (Reformed) has the same form and the same words (Sehling 22, pp. 271–275).

2.4.8 The early German Masses

Before the territorial orders. The German Masses of 1522–1526 (Kantz at Nördlingen, Müntzer at Allstedt (Radical Reformation), the Strasbourg and Worms Masses (Moderate Reformed), Volprecht and Döber at Nürnberg, the Low German Masses of Bremen, Lippe and Kiel) are compared part by part in Chapter 7, §§7.2–7.11. They keep the Roman shape and translate it, the canon included, before the *Deutsche Messe* (German Mass) set the pattern for the parishes. Two of their ordinaries recur below: Müntzer's fourfold Kyrie (§2.6.1) and Volprecht's *Benedicamus* "and never *Ite missa est*" (§2.13).

2.5 The ordos compared

How to read the table. Each row gives the sequence of the Sunday Mass with communicants, in the shorthand set out in the Conventions. Brackets mark a part the order allows but does not require. "→" separates the parts. Details of each ordinary are in §§2.6–2.13; the propers, hymns and prayers in the chapters named at the head of this chapter.

Order	Sehling	Family	Ordo
Luther, *Formula missae*, 1523	1, pp. 5–6	Latin, purged	Intr → Ky (seasonal) → Gl (bishop may omit) → one Coll → Ep → Grad + Alleluia → Gosp → Nicene Cr (optional) → Serm (or before the Intr) → Pref with Verba → San with Benedictus (elevation) → PN → Pax → Comm with Agn → *Quod ore* (What with our mouth) → *Benedicamus* → Bl
Luther, *Deutsche Messe*, 1526	1, pp. 14–16	German	German psalm → Ky ×3 → Coll → Ep → German hymn → Gosp → "Wir glauben" (We believe) → Serm → paraphrase of PN + Exh → Verba (bread) → Comm with German San → Verba (cup) → Comm → German Agn → Thanks → Bl (Num 6)
Prussia, *Artikel der ceremonien*, 1525	4, pp. 31–33	Prussian	Intr → Ky ×3 (Greek, Latin, German) → Gl → Coll → Ep (a chapter) → Alleluia with German psalm → Gosp (a chapter) → Cr in German, not intoned → Pref with Verba → bell, elevation → San → PN → Agn ×2 → Pax → Exh → Comm with hymns → Thanks → Bl
Brandenburg-Nürnberg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1533	11, pp. 188–198	Franconian	private *Confiteor* (I confess) → Intr → Ky + *Et in terra* (And on earth) → *Dominus vobiscum* (The Lord be with you) → Coll(s) → Ep (a chapter) → Alleluia or Grad → Gosp (a chapter) → Cr → Serm → Exh → Verba → San → *Oremus praeceptis* + PN → Pax → Comm with Agn → Thanks → *Benedicamus* → Bl
Wittenberg, town order, 1533	1, pp. 704–705	Saxon	German Benedictus → Intr → Ky ×3, or ×9 on feasts → [Gl] → German Coll → Ep → Alleluia/Grad, German hymn, sequence → Gosp → *Credo* intoned, *Patrem* (the Nicene Creed), "Wir glauben" → Serm → *Da pacem* (Give peace) → versicle + Coll → [*Dominus vobiscum* + Pref on feasts] → PN → Verba (elevation) → Comm with hymns, Latin Agn → German Agn ×3 → Thanks → Bl (Num 6)
Pomerania, *Kirchenordnung*, 1535	4, p. 341	Bugenhagen	German psalm or Intr → Ky → [Gl] → German Coll → Ep → psalm, alleluia, sequence → Gosp → *Credo* intoned, *Patrem*, "Wi löven" (We believe) → Serm + general prayer → hymn → [Pref + San] → [Exh] → PN + Verba → Comm with Agn and hymns → German Agn → Coll → Bl (Num 6); "after the Amen nothing more is sung"
Albertine Saxony, *Kirchenordnunge zum anfang* (Duke Henry), 1539	1, pp. 274–275	Saxon	Intr → Ky (seasonal, or ×3) → Gl + *Et in terra* → Coll → Ep → Gosp → Latin *Patrem* + "Wir glauben" → Serm → [Latin Pref on feasts] → paraphrase of PN + Exh (or PN sung) → Verba → Comm with Latin Agn or German hymns → German Agn → Coll → Bl → "Gott sei gelobet" (God be praised)
Brandenburg, *Kirchen-ordnung*, 1540	3, pp. 68–70	Latin frame	Intr → Ky → Gl + *Et in terra* → *Dominus vobiscum* + Coll → Ep → Alleluia + sequence → Gosp → *Credo*, *Patrem* (German in parishes) → *Dominus vobiscum* without *Oremus* → offertory chant → Pref → Latin San (prayers said under it) → Verba (German, elevation) → PN (German) → Pax → Agn ×3 → Exh → Comm with *Discubuit Jesus* (Jesus sat at table) → Thanks → *Quod ore*
Braunschweig-Wolfenbüttel, *Kirchenordnung*, 1543	6/1, pp. 54–56	Bugenhagen	German Benedictus → German psalm → Ky ×3 (prayer at the altar) → Gl intoned, *Et in terra*, "Allein Gott" (To God alone), *Laudamus* → one Coll → Ep → Alleluia, German psalm, [sequence] → Gosp → *Credo*

Order	Sehling	Family	Ordo
			intoned, *Patrem*, "Wy geloven" (We believe) → Serm → Exh → … (as Pomerania)
Palatinate, *Gemaine maß*, 1546	14, pp. 96–97	Latin frame	versicle + Coll → Intr → Ky (each once) → *Et in terra* → Coll → Ep → Alleluia + sequence or tract → Gosp → *Credo* intoned, Latin Nicene Cr, "Wir glauben" → Serm → Exh → *Per omnia saecula* (World without end), *Dominus vobiscum*, *Sursum corda* (Lift up your hearts) → [whole Pref on high feasts] → San to the Agn → PN (German) → Verba → Pax → Comm …
Transylvania, *Kirchenordnung* (German), 1547	24, p. 244	Saxon	German Benedictus (or *Salve festa dies* [Hail, festal day]) → Intr → Ky + *Et in terra* → Coll → Ep → sequence or tract → Gosp → "Wir glauben" or Latin *Credo* → *Dominus vobiscum*, Pref, San → PN → Verba → Agn, hymns during Comm → *Dominus vobiscum*, Coll → *Benedicamus* → Trinitarian Bl; the sermon is held before the Mass, after Matins, and again after dinner
Mecklenburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1552	5, pp. 198–199	Bugenhagen	confession and absolution → Intr → Ky → Gl or "Allein Gott" → *Dominus vobiscum* → German Coll → Ep → sequence or hymn → Gosp → *Credo* intoned, *Patrem*, "Wir glauben" → Serm (about an hour) + prayer → [*Dominus vobiscum* + Pref + San] → [Exh] → PN + Verba sung (no elevation) → Comm with hymns, Agn, Isaiah → "Christe du Lamm Gottes" (Christ, thou Lamb of God) → Thanks → Bl (Num 6) → "Erhalt uns" (Keep us)
Württemberg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1553	16, pp. 252–255	Upper German	German hymn → Serm → German Cr → Exh → general prayer → "Vater unser" (Our Father) sung → confession and absolution → Verba read → Comm with hymns → Thanks → Bl
Breslau, report on the order of the churches, 1557	3, p. 404	Latin frame	high Mass sung "as of old" to the Gosp and *Patrem* → Serm → Pref → elevation → Comm → San, Agn, communion chant → postcommunion → *Benedicamus* or *Ite missa est* (Go, it is the dismissal)
Palatinate, *Kirchenordnung*, 1563 (Reformed)	14, pp. 383–387	Reformed	Serm on the Supper → Sunday prayer → the Form: Verba (1 Cor 11), self-examination, exclusion → prayer + PN → Apostles' Cr → hearts lifted up → breaking of bread (1 Cor 10:16) → Comm with singing or reading → Thanks (Ps 103) + prayer
Hesse, *Kirchenordnung*, 1566 (Moderate Reformed)	8, pp. 237–254	Hessian	confession and absolution, or Ps 51 → German Ky + Gl → Coll → Ep → psalm or sequence → Gosp → Apostles' Cr sung by all → Serm → general prayer → confession → notices and alms → Supper
Albertine Saxony, *Ordnung* of Duke August, 1580	1, pp. 368–369	Saxon	Intr → Ky → Latin Gl + *Et in terra* → Coll → Ep (German) → sequence or psalm → Gosp (German) → *Credo*, Latin *Patrem*, "Wir glauben" → Serm → paraphrase of PN + Exh → Verba sung → Comm with Latin Agn, Isaiah, Ps 111, hymns → Coll → Bl (Num 6)
Bentheim-Tecklenburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1588 (Reformed)	22, pp. 271–275	Reformed	as the Palatinate 1563 → psalm → Bl
Hof, *Ordo ecclesiasticus*, 1592	11, pp. 425–426	Franconian	Intr → Ky de tempore (three choirs) → Gl intoned, *Et in terra* in alternation → epistle prayer + Ep → German psalm → gospel prayer + Gosp → "Wir glauben" → "Nun bitten wir" (Now pray we) kneeling → Serm → *Dominus vobiscum* + Coll → Exh → PN → Pax → Verba → Comm with San and Agn de tempore, Isaiah, hymns

Order	Sehling	Family	Ordo
Strasbourg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1598	20/1, pp. 610–612	Upper German	Sunday sermon service to the prayer after the Serm → German *Grates nunc omnes* (Let us all now give thanks) while the bread and wine are set out → Exh (Württemberg text) → …

What the table shows.

- **Everyone kept the readings, the sermon, the Verba and a closing blessing.** The epistle and gospel (or chapters in course), a sermon, the Words of Institution, a distribution with singing, a thanksgiving and a blessing are in every row.
- **The ordinaries divide the families.** The Saxon, Bugenhagen, Franconian, Prussian and Latin-frame orders keep Kyrie, Gloria and Creed, and some form of Sanctus and Agnus Dei. The Upper German (Lutheran) and Reformed orders keep only a creed: the German "Wir glauben" in Württemberg, the Apostles' Creed in the Reformed Palatinate.
- **The Preface was the first casualty.** Only the Prussian, Franconian-Hof, Latin-frame and Transylvanian orders require it. The Saxon and Bugenhagen orders make it optional or festal; the *Deutsche Messe* (German Mass), Albertine Saxony 1580, Nürnberg 1533 and Württemberg drop it (§2.10).
- **The Verba and the Lord's Prayer travel.** The Lord's Prayer comes before the Verba (Saxony, Bugenhagen, Transylvania, Hof), after them (*Formula missae*, Prussia, Nürnberg 1533, Brandenburg 1540), as a paraphrase in the exhortation (*Deutsche Messe*, Saxony 1539, 1580), as a hymn before the confession (Württemberg), or inside the prayer before the creed (Palatinate, Reformed) (§2.11).
- **The sermon has two homes.** It follows the gospel and creed almost everywhere. The *Formula missae* allowed it before the introit, and Transylvania (1547) held the first sermon after Matins, before the Mass began (Sehling 24, p. 244).

2.6 The Kyrie

The hymns sung as or with the Kyrie, the troped German Kyries and the Kyrie in three tongues are treated in Chapter 8, §8.6. This section asks how many acclamations were sung, and which of the old Kyrie chants survived.

2.6.1 Three, four or nine

The medieval norm was nine. The Roman Kyrie had nine acclamations: Kyrie three times, Christe three times, Kyrie three times. The Hannover order of 1536 repeats the common attribution: "To sing the Kyrie eleison nine times, Gregory the Great set up in the Roman church, as Platina writeth; yet it came first from the Greek church" (Sehling 6/2, p. 1005).

Luther: three, not nine. The *Deutsche Messe* (German Mass) cut the Kyrie to three acclamations, "three times and not nine times" (§2.3.3). The threefold Kyrie became the norm of the German parish service:

- Duke Henry's Saxony (1539): "on ordinary Sundays and in the villages one may sing it plain … only three times" (Sehling 1, p. 274);
- the visitation articles for Gnandstein (1539) and the *Gemeine Artikel* (Common Articles) for the see of Wurzen (1542): "Kyrie eleison three times" (Sehling 1, p. 564; 2, p. 98);
- Prussia (1525, 1544 and 1568): "since it is sung three times", in three tongues (1525); "the Kyrie eleison only three times, according to the former order" (1544, 1568) (Sehling 4, pp. 32, 64, 81);
- the Palatinate (1546): "the Kyrie eleison, each only once" (Sehling 14, p. 96);
- the Henneberg parishes of Suhl (1562) and Obermaßfeld (1563): "the German Kyrie three times" (Sehling 2, pp. 352, 346);
- Waldeck (1556): "a Kyrie eleison three times" (Sehling 9, p. 247).

Nine on the feasts. The ninefold Kyrie survived where there was a choir, and especially on feasts. At Wittenberg the plain threefold Kyrie was "the right Kyrie", the ninefold the festal one (Sehling 1, p. 704; quoted in §2.7.1). The Pomeranian order of 1542 gives the Sunday Kyrie "three or nine times, or the Kyrie of the feast" (Sehling 4, p. 358). The Braunschweig-Wolfenbüttel order of 1543 gives the reason for three, and leaves the festal number to the schoolmaster. **Braunschweig-Wolfenbüttel, *Christlike kerken-ordeninge*, 1543** (Sehling 6/1, p. 54):

It is not needful to repeat the *eleison* or Kyrie nine times; it is enough to sing it three times, in the name of the Father and of the Son and of the Holy Ghost, without the organ. Yet the scholars may well sing another Kyrie on the feasts, especially when they

sing in figured music, three times, four times or nine times, at the schoolmaster's pleasure; yet so that one make it not too long with the singing and the organ, that the sermon be not hindered thereby.

Four. A fourfold form, Kyrie, Christe, Kyrie, Kyrie, appears in three places:

- Müntzer's *Deutsch evangelisch Messe* (German Evangelical Mass) of 1524 (Radical Reformation): "Kyrie leyson, Christe leyson, kyrie leyson, kyrie leyson" (Sehling 1, p. 499);
- the German Masses of the Calenberg-Göttingen order of 1542, which take the chants of Müntzer (Radical Reformation): some have the fourfold form, others the threefold (Sehling 6/2, pp. 812, 817, 825, 827, 829; three: pp. 820, 823, 832);
- the song appendix of the Hessian *Agende* of 1574 (Philippist), after the German introit for Trinity: "Kyrie eleison. Christe eleison. Kyrie eleison. Kyrie eleison" (Sehling 8, p. 465).

The fourth acclamation is the closing Kyrie of the chant, sung to its own melody, kept when the middle repetitions were cut. Braunschweig-Wolfenbüttel's "four times" in figured music (above) is the same shape set polyphonically.

One, by three choirs. At Hof (1592) the German Kyrie was divided among three choirs, one acclamation each: "the first choir singeth Kyrie eleison in German, the second Christe eleison, the third, or the girls' choir, Kyrie eleison". In figured music the organ played each of the three before the choir answered; otherwise the organ "preludeth once only before the *Et in terra*" (Sehling 11, p. 425).

Not found. No order prescribes a sevenfold Kyrie, and none a sixfold one. The counts in the corpus are three, four and nine, with the "each once" of the Palatinate (1546) amounting to three.

2.6.2 Which Kyrie: the seasonal chants

The old melodies kept. The *Formula missae* (Form of the Mass) kept the Kyrie "with various melodies for the various seasons" (§2.3.2). The northern and Franconian orders name the chants they meant, by their medieval titles. **Pomerania, *Kirchenordnung*, 1542** (Sehling 4, p. 356):

Thereupon the *Kyrie dominicale*; or one may also sing on the Sundays the *Kyrie angelicum*, *de martyribus* (of martyrs), or *confessoribus*, or *virginibus*, as they have been named; the *dominicale* (Sunday [Kyrie]) in Advent and in Lent, the *paschale* (Easter [Kyrie]) between Easter and Whitsun, the *summum* (the highest [chant]) on the higher feasts, or the *minus summum* (the lesser summum).

The fullest scheme is the Hof order of 1592, for the boys' daily Mass-shaped service sung from the "great missal". **Hof, *Ordo ecclesiasticus*, 1592** (Sehling 11, p. 472):

Next, secondly, there is sung out of the great missal the Kyrie of the proper season: either the *angelicum* (angelic [Kyrie]) in the Advent of the Lord, or the Kyrie *Magne Deus potentiae* (O God of great power) of the Nativity of Christ, to which the angelic *Et in terra* (And on earth) is joined; or the greater *dominicale* from the Sunday Septuagesima until Easter; or the *paschale*; or the Kyrie *Fons bonitatis* (Fount of goodness) with the angelic *Et in terra*; or the lesser *dominicale* after the feast of Trinity; or that of the apostles, martyrs, etc., as the season requireth and the order of the book showeth.

The same order assigns, Sunday by Sunday, a "Kyrie angelicum seu feriale" (angelic or ferial Kyrie) in Advent, a "Kyrie paschale" (Easter Kyrie) from Easter to the Ascension, and a "Kyrie dominicale" from the fourth Sunday after Trinity to Advent, with the Sanctus and Agnus Dei of the same set (Sehling 11, pp. 432–450).

Other lists.

- **Buxtehude 1565**: a table of the Kyries by occasion: "On the highest feasts and Trinity Sunday … the lesser *summum*", "On the feasts of the blessed Virgin Mary", "*Kyrie paschale*", "*Dominicale*" (Sunday [Kyrie]), "*In Adventu Domini*" (In the Advent of the Lord), "*Angelicum*", "*Kyrie apostolicum*" (apostles' Kyrie) (Sehling 7/1, p. 123).
- **Nördlingen 1544**: German Kyries "according to the season, of which we have three at this time": the *paschale* from Easter to Whitsun, *Fons bonitatis* from Whitsun to Christmas, *Magne Deus* (Great God) from Christmas to Easter; and the "*Kyrie summum* with the *Et in terra*" at Whitsun and Trinity, with the "*Sanctus summus*" (Sehling 12, pp. 318, 321–322).
- **Mecklenburg, *Ordeninge der misse*, 1540/1545**: the Kyrie "according to the season, as hath been kept hitherto"; in the villages the pastors are to teach the people "the German *Kyrie summum* (highest Kyrie), *Ach vader, alder högeste godt* (Ah Father, God most high)" (Sehling 5, p. 151).

- **Schleswig-Holstein 1542**: "The Kyrie eleison may be sung with manifold notes according to the difference of the season, as hath been kept hitherto" (Sehling 23, p. 90).
- **Pfalz-Zweibrücken 1557**: the song index lists a *Kyrie paschale*, a Kyrie "*in adventu domini*" (in the Advent of the Lord), an *angelicum* and an *apostolicum* (apostles' [Kyrie]), each with its Gloria (Sehling 18, p. 255). The hymn plan of 1565 marks "the second Kyrie" for ordinary Sundays (Sehling 18, p. 337).
- **Schweinfurt 1576**: the organ begins "the Latin *Kyrie dominicale*, which the choir repeateth" (Sehling 11, pp. 647–648).
- **Nördlingen 1579**: the Latin Kyries of the weekday office: the *Fons bonitatis* in Advent, the *Magne Deus* at Christmas and in Lent, the *dominicale* from Septuagesima and at Pentecost, the *paschale* from Easter, and on the other Sundays the Kyrie "without the text" (Sehling 12, pp. 377–380; Chapter 8, §8.6.4.7).

So the old cycle of Kyrie chants, *Lux et origo* (Light and origin; the Easter Kyrie), *Fons bonitatis* (Fount of goodness), *Magne Deus* (Great God), *Cunctipotens* (Almighty; the apostles' Kyrie), *Orbis factor* (Maker of the world; the Sunday Kyrie) and the rest, survived in the Lutheran churches that had Latin schools, assigned to the seasons as before. Where the orders print a text, it is the plain Kyrie, or a new German trope set to the old melody. The old Latin tropes are named by their opening words (Nördlingen 1579), or left out by Sehling's editor (Buxtehude 1565), and are printed in full only once, in Hof's Holy Week office. The Latin texts of the *Fons bonitatis* and the *Magne Deus* are given from outside the corpus in Chapter 8, §8.6.4.7.

2.6.3 Which language

Latin, German, Greek. The Kyrie is the one ordinary the orders most often leave untranslated. The Homberg synod of 1526 (Moderate Reformed) kept "these accustomed little words, *Kyrie eleyson*, *Hallelujah*, *Hosiannah*, *Sabaoth*, *Amen*", to be explained to the people (Sehling 8, p. 45). Bugenhagen defended the Greek at length (Braunschweig 1528, Sehling 6/1, p. 438; Chapter 8, §8.6.3). Prussia sang it in three languages, "since it is sung three times". **Prussia, *Artikel der ceremonien und anderer kirchen ordnung*, 1525** (Sehling 4, p. 32):

Of the Kyrie eleison it is thought good, since it is sung three times, that it be sung in three tongues, as is the custom here also: Greek, Latin and German. *Gloria in excelsis* and *Et in terra* (And on earth) may be sung in German or Latin, as is convenient.

The Livonian towns took the same rule in 1533 (Sehling 5, p. 15). Neuenrade (1564) prints such Kyries, in Greek, Latin and Low German, to several melodies (Sehling 22, pp. 527–528; Chapter 8, §8.6.2).

2.7 The Gloria

The German Gloria hymns ("Allein Gott in der Höh", "All Ehr und Lob"), the alternation of Latin and German Sunday by Sunday, and the omission of the Gloria in Advent, Lent and winter are treated in Chapter 8, §8.7. Three further points belong to the ordo.

2.7.1 The Gloria belongs to the festal Kyrie

Not after the plain Kyrie. In the medieval Mass the Gloria went with a festal Kyrie and was silent on ferias and penitential days. Wittenberg kept the rule. **Wittenberg, *Kirchen-Ordnung für die Stadt Wittenberg*, 1533** (Sehling 1, p. 704):

Thereafter the right Kyrie three times; or at times, especially on the feasts, another one nine times, as is customary. After the plain Kyrie one singeth not the *Gloria in excelsis Deo* (Glory to God in the highest), but after the others, when one will, and especially on the feasts.

The Brandenburg order of 1540 ties the two together: the Kyrie "according to occasion", then the Gloria, "which together with the *Et in terra* belongeth to the Kyrie" (Sehling 3, p. 68). The *Formula missae* (Form of the Mass) left it to the bishop "how often he will have it left out" (§2.3.2), and the *Deutsche Messe* (German Mass) left it out altogether.

2.7.2 Intonation, *Et in terra*, and the divided Gloria

The priest intones. Where the Gloria was sung, the priest (or a deacon, or at Hof a boy) intoned *Gloria in excelsis Deo* (Glory to God in the highest), and the choir continued *Et in terra pax* (And on earth peace). In the German orders the priest sang "Glory be to God on high" and the people answered with "Allein Gott" (To God alone). The orders of the north divided the Latin Gloria between the scholars, the people and the organ. **Braunschweig-Wolfenbüttel, *Christlike kerken-ordeninge*, 1543** (Sehling 6/1, p. 55):

After the Kyrie the priest singeth: *Gloria in excelsis Deo*. The scholars' choir answereth and singeth: *Et in terra pax hominibus bonae voluntatis* (And on earth peace to men of good will), no more. Straightway the whole church singeth "To God alone on high be glory," etc., in full.

The scholars and the organ then continue the Latin *Laudamus te* (We praise thee) "in full" (Sehling 6/1, p. 55). So the Gloria was sung twice over: once in its Latin form, divided between the priest, the scholars and the organ, and once as Decius's hymn by the people. The Pomeranian order of 1542 allows either half to be dropped "when it will grow too long" (Sehling 4, p. 356).

At Hof, the minister intoned a Gloria "suited to the Mass and answering to the season"; the organ began the *Et in terra* (And on earth), "divided into certain portions", which the three choirs finished in alternation with the organ. In the hardest frost the organ only began it and the choir sang the rest (Sehling 11, p. 425).

2.7.3 The Gloria and the Kyrie as one piece

One unit. Because the Gloria followed the Kyrie and shared its chant, several orders treat the two as a single piece: "the Kyrie and the *Et in terra*" (Brandenburg-Nürnberg 1533; Kurpfalz 1546; Transylvania 1547; Nördlingen 1544), "Kyrie eleison with the *Gloria in excelsis et in terra pax*, as it is put into German and printed in the song-books" (Hesse 1566, Moderate Reformed, Sehling 8, p. 239). The Hof order of 1592 assigns to each seasonal Kyrie its own *Et in terra* (And on earth): "the Kyrie *Magne Deus potentiae* … to which the angelic *Et in terra* is joined" (§2.6.2). In East Frisia (1535) the Kyrie and Gloria together were sung "as it is sung in the song *Allein Gott in der Höh sei Ehr*" (Chapter 8, §8.6.5).

2.8 Salutation, collect and Pax

The collect and postcommunion are treated in Chapter 5. Here the fixed formulas around them.

The salutation. *Dominus vobiscum* (The Lord be with you) before the collect survived in most of the Latin-shaped orders, often given in German beside the Latin:

- Mecklenburg 1552: the salutation *Dominus vobiscum*, answered *Et cum spiritu tuo* (And with thy spirit), each with its German (Sehling 5, p. 198);
- Brandenburg-Nürnberg 1533: *Dominus vobiscum* or its German (Sehling 11, p. 188);
- Hof 1592: "The Lord be with you! Chorus: And with thy spirit", sung "either chorally or figurally" (Sehling 11, p. 425);
- Transylvania 1547: before the Preface and again before the postcommunion collect (Sehling 24, p. 244).

Bugenhagen's Braunschweig-Wolfenbüttel order dropped it: "*Dominus vobiscum*, or *De Here sy mit ju*, is not needful to say" (Sehling 6/1, p. 55). The *Deutsche Messe* (German Mass) and the Württemberg and Reformed orders have no salutation.

The Pax. The *Formula missae* (Form of the Mass) kept *Pax Domini sit semper vobiscum* (The peace of the Lord be always with you) after the Lord's Prayer as "a kind of public absolution from sins … the one and most worthy preparation for the Lord's Table" (Sehling 1, p. 6). The Pax stayed where the Lord's Prayer stayed near the altar:

- Prussia 1525: "the priest turneth to the people and giveth them the evangelical absolution, or the peace, and singeth in German *Pax domini*" (Sehling 4, p. 32);
- Brandenburg-Nürnberg 1533, after the Lord's Prayer: "*Pax Domini sit semper vobiscum*, or else in German" (§2.4.3);
- Brandenburg 1540: "*The peace of the Lord be with you all*. Let all the people say *Amen*" (Sehling 3, p. 69);
- the Palatinate 1546, after the Verba: "the peace of the Lord be with you all. The choir answereth: Amen" (Sehling 14, p. 97);
- Hof 1592: "The peace of the Lord be with you all" (Sehling 11, p. 426).

The *Deutsche Messe*, the Saxon orders of 1539 and 1580, the Pomeranian and Mecklenburg orders and Württemberg have no Pax.

The Preface dialogue is treated with the Preface (§2.10).

2.9 The Creed

The German creed-hymn "Wir glauben all" (We all believe) and its places in the service are treated in Chapter 8, §8.9. This section asks which creed was used, and who began it.

2.9.1 Intoned by the priest, sung by the choir, then by the people

Three layers. In the Saxon and Bugenhagen orders the creed was sung three times over: the priest intoned the Nicene Creed in Latin at the altar, the scholars sang the Latin *Patrem* (the Nicene Creed) to the end, and the people then sang "Wir glauben all" (We all believe). **Wittenberg, *Kirchen-Ordnung für die Stadt Wittenberg*, 1533** (Sehling 1, p. 704):

Thereafter the priest singeth the gospel turned toward the people, thereafter, [turned] again toward the altar, *Credo in unum Deum* (I believe in one God). Thereupon the scholars sing the *Patrem* in Latin, then with the people "We all believe in one God". But often the schoolmaster beginneth "We believe", etc., straight after the gospel, for brevity's sake.

The same three layers are in Pomerania 1535 ("the *Patrem* in full, *dominicaliter*"), Braunschweig-Wolfenbüttel 1543, Duke Henry's Saxony 1539 ("the Latin *Patrem* in full, after the common notes"), Mecklenburg 1552 (with the Latin text and notes), the Palatinate 1546 and Saxony 1580 (Sehling 4, p. 341; 6/1, p. 55; 1, p. 274; 5, p. 198; 14, p. 96; 1, p. 368). Brandenburg (1540) sang the Latin *Patrem* "in cathedrals and foundations", and "Wir glauben" (We believe) in the parishes (Sehling 3, p. 68).

Not intoned. Prussia (1525) abolished the priest's intonation: "The *Credo* or creed the priest shall not begin as heretofore, but it shall be sung in German by the choir and the people" (Sehling 4, p. 32).

2.9.2 Nicene, Apostles' or Athanasian

The Nicene Creed in the Lutheran Mass. The Latin *Credo* of the Mass is the Nicene Creed, and "Wir glauben all" (We all believe) is Luther's paraphrase of it. Sangerhausen (1555) calls the people's German creed "the customary *Symbolum Nicaenum* in German" (Sehling 1, p. 658). Weissenfels (1578) sometimes sang "the *Symbolum Nicenum*" in figured music before the German creed (Sehling 1, p. 693).

The Apostles' Creed in Hesse and the Reformed orders. The Hessian order of 1566 (Moderate Reformed) put the Apostles' Creed in the Mass, sung by everyone every Sunday, and kept the Nicene and Athanasian Creeds for the feasts of Christ. **Hesse, *Kirchenordnung*, 1566** (Moderate Reformed; Sehling 8, pp. 242–243):

But this creed and confession of faith is sung by the whole church every Sunday with clear voice after the reading of the gospel, and that for the following causes [...] But on the feasts of Christ one may sing or read the Nicene Creed or that of Athanasius, which are very profitable for the strengthening of our faith and for withstanding the heretics who in manifold ways have assailed and blasphemed the honour and the two natures of Christ, the Son of God.

The Palatine order of 1563 (Reformed) has the communicants confess the Apostles' Creed "with mouth and heart" inside the Supper form (§2.4.7). Nördlingen (1579) had "an article of the Apostles' Creed with the short exposition of Luther's catechism" read before the German creed on feast days (Sehling 12, p. 366).

The Athanasian Creed was read or sung on Trinity Sunday in some places: as the text of the early sermon at Schweinfurt (1543) and at Altenburg (1554) (Sehling 11, p. 638; 1, p. 519). Its place was otherwise the morning office (Chapter 10, §10.7).

2.9.3 Where the creed fell

After the gospel nearly everywhere; after the sermon in Württemberg, where the creed was sung "in German" when the sermon was over (Sehling 16, p. 252); and inside the Supper form in the Reformed Palatinate. The places of the creed-hymn as offertory, as cover for the preacher's movement to the pulpit, and as a substitute for "Nun bitten wir" (Now pray we) are in Chapter 8, §§8.9.1–8.9.4.

2.9.4 Which creed, order by order

Four practices. A search of the corpus for the creeds named in or near the Mass (*Credo in unum Deum*, *Patrem*, *symbolum Nicenum*, *symbolum apostolicum*, *Credo in Deum Patrem*, "Ich glaub in Gott Vater", *Athanasii*) gives four practices:

- **The Nicene Creed only**, in Latin, in German verse by verse, or as Luther's "Wir glauben all" (We all believe). This is the rule of the Saxon, Bugenhagen and Franconian orders.
- **The Apostles' Creed only**, sung or said: Strasbourg (1524, Moderate Reformed), the foundation Mass at Goslar, the Upper German pulpit, the Reformed Supper.
- **A choice left open**, Nicene or Apostles', Latin or German, with no rule for when.

- **A choice by occasion**: one creed on Sundays, another on feasts.

Strasbourg: the Apostles' Creed sung, the Nicene by some. The Strasbourg German Mass of 1524 (Moderate Reformed) prints the Apostles' Creed with notes after the sermon, in Matthäus Greiter's setting, and leaves the Nicene to those who want it. **Strasbourg, *Ordenung und inhalt Teutscher Mess*, 1524** (Moderate Reformed; Sehling 20/1, p. 138):

Then followeth the sermon. Thereafter the Creed: "I believe in God the Father Almighty, maker of heaven and earth" [...] The great *Patrem*, which is called the Nicene Creed, is sung by some.

The earlier Strasbourg Mass of Theobald Schwarz (1524, Moderate Reformed) had the Nicene Creed in German, "I believe in one God, the almighty Father" (Sehling 20/1, p. 121).

By occasion: Sundays and feasts. Hesse (1566, Moderate Reformed) gave the Apostles' Creed to every Sunday and the Nicene or Athanasian to the feasts of Christ (§2.9.2). The Rothenberg ministers of 1618 reversed the scheme: "Wir glauben" (We believe) on Sundays, the Apostles' Creed word for word on the other feasts. **Rothenberg, *Christliche vereinigung* of the ministers, 1618** (Sehling 13, p. 548):

After the boys have stepped down, let the customary creed be sung on the Sundays: "We all believe in one God", etc. But on the other holy days the Apostles' Creed in German, word for word: "I believe in God the Father Almighty", etc.

A free choice of three. The Hessian *Agende* of 1574 (Philippist) lets the Apostles' Creed, Luther's creed-hymn or the Nicene be sung after the gospel. On occasion the Nicene or the Athanasian Creed might instead be read aloud at the altar. **Hesse, *Agende*, 1574** (Philippist; Sehling 8, p. 411):

Upon the reading of the gospel is sung the Apostles' Creed in German, word for word, or as Doctor Luther hath set it in the manner of a song by way of paraphrase, or the Nicene Creed in German. One may also now and then, after the gospel, sing the German *Grates nunc omnes* (Let us all now give thanks), or another short song, and thereupon read the Nicene or Athanasian Creed with a clear voice to the people before the altar.

The Hessian *Agende* (Philippist) counts "Wir glauben all" as a paraphrase of the Apostles' Creed, not of the Nicene. The Corvey order for Bruchhausen (1603) does the same: "the Apostles' Creed, as Dr Luther set it in German in the manner of a song", where Sehling's editors identify the song as "Wir glauben all" (Sehling 21, p. 244). Most orders, and the modern editors, take it as the Nicene.

The table. The orders that say which creed belongs in the Sunday Mass or service:

Order	Sehling	Creed	By occasion
Luther, *Formula missae*, 1523	1, p. 5	Nicene, Latin, at the bishop's choice	—
Volprecht, Nürnberg, 1524	11, p. 41	Nicene in German, "I believe in one God"	—
Schwarz, Strasbourg, 1524 (Moderate Reformed)	20/1, p. 121	Nicene in German	—
Strasbourg, *Ordenung und inhalt*, 1524 (Moderate Reformed)	20/1, p. 138	Apostles' Creed, sung after the sermon	Nicene "by some"
Luther, *Deutsche Messe*, 1526	1, p. 14	"Wir glauben all"	—
Braunschweig 1528; Hamburg 1529	6/1, p. 440; 5, p. 531	priest intones "I believe in one God"; people sing the whole Nicene in Low German verse by verse; then "Wy gelöven" (We believe)	—
Goslar, town order, 1528	7/2.2, p. 242	"the Nicene Creed or the German *Patrem*, Wir glauben"	—

Order	Sehling	Creed	By occasion
Goslar, foundation of St. Simon and Jude, 1534	7/2.2, p. 263	*Credo in Deum Patrem* (Apostles') after the gospel	—
Wittenberg 1533 and the Saxon and Bugenhagen orders	§2.9.1	*Credo in unum Deum* intoned, Latin *Patrem*, "Wir glauben"	"Wir glauben" alone for brevity
Northeim 1539	6/2, p. 925	"the Nicene Creed or Wir glauben in German"	—
Brandenburg 1540	3, p. 68	Latin *Patrem*	in cathedrals and foundations; "Wir glauben" in parishes
Schwäbisch Hall, 1543 (1615 revision)	17/1, p. 163	a hymn "with the Apostles' Creed, as a mark of the Church", or "Nun bitten wir" (Now pray we), at the start of the Sunday service	—
Württemberg 1553	16, pp. 239, 252	German creed sung after the sermon; the Apostles' Creed said from the pulpit every Sunday with the Decalogue and Lord's Prayer	—
Frankfurt, French Reformed church, 1554 (Reformed)	9, p. 567	Apostles' Creed sung by the people while the bread and wine are brought	—
Sangerhausen 1555	1, p. 658	"the customary Nicene Creed in German"	—
Hamburg, Latin account, 1556	5, p. 543	*symbolum apostolorum* (Apostles' Creed) after the gospel, before the Latin Preface	—
Ritzebüttel (Hamburg), 1556	5, p. 559	Apostles' Creed after the gospel	on apostles' days and lesser holy days
Feuchtwangen 1563	11, p. 399	*Credo in unum Deum Patrem omnipotentem* one Sunday, the German creed the next	alternating Sundays
Palatinate 1563 (Reformed)	14, p. 386	Apostles' Creed within the Supper form (§2.4.7)	—
Hesse 1566 (Moderate Reformed)	8, pp. 242–243, 254	Apostles' Creed every Sunday; "Wir glauben" or the Apostles' Creed in the shorter service	Nicene or Athanasian on the feasts of Christ
Prussia 1568	4, p. 81	Latin Nicene in the cathedral	elsewhere alternating Sunday by Sunday with "Wir glauben"
Pomerania, *Agenda*, 1569	4, p. 438	Nicene in Latin or Low German, or "Wi gelöven" (We believe)	—
Kurland 1570	5, p. 88	Latin *Patrem*, or the Apostles' Creed sung, or "Wir gleuben" (We believe)	—
Hesse, *Agende*, 1574 (Philippist)	8, p. 411	Apostles' word for word, Luther's paraphrase, or Nicene in German	Nicene or Athanasian sometimes read aloud
Weissenfels 1578	1, p. 693	figured Nicene before the German creed	some days
Corvey (Bruchhausen) 1603	21, p. 244	"Wir glauben all", called the Apostles' Creed	—
Rothenberg 1618	13, p. 548	"Wir glauben all" on Sundays	Apostles' word for word on other feasts

What the table shows.

- The Nicene Creed, sung in Latin by the choir and in German by the people, is the Lutheran norm north and east.
- The Apostles' Creed entered the Mass from three directions:
  - the Upper German sermon service (Strasbourg 1524, Moderate Reformed; Schwäbisch Hall and Württemberg's pulpit, Lutheran);
  - the Reformed Supper (Frankfurt's French church, the Palatinate; both Reformed);
  - Hesse (Moderate Reformed), where it was the creed of the whole congregation every Sunday.
- The Athanasian Creed was never the Sunday creed. It was read on the feasts of Christ in Hesse (Moderate Reformed) and on Trinity Sunday in a few places (§2.9.2), and otherwise belonged to the morning office.
- The weekday offices of Naumburg (1537) and Nördlingen (1544, 1579) gave the Nicene Creed its own day, Friday or Thursday, in a weekly round of canticles (Sehling 2, p. 72; 12, pp. 326, 377); that is office, not Mass.

2.10 The Preface and the Sanctus

The Proper Prefaces, their texts and the days they were used, are in Chapter 4, §4.8 and Appendix 4.A; the German Sanctus hymns ("Jesaia dem Propheten", the Trinitarian "Heilig ist Gott der Vater") in Chapter 8, §8.12.

2.10.1 The Preface: required, optional, festal or gone

Four answers. The orders give four answers to the question whether the Preface was sung:

- **Required.** The *Formula missae* (Form of the Mass), Prussia 1525, Brandenburg 1540, Transylvania 1547 and the Breslau Mass of 1557 have it in the ordo, with the dialogue (§§2.4.4–2.4.5).
- **If time allows.** Mecklenburg (1552) makes it the priest's choice "if the time permit".
- **Festal.** Wittenberg 1533 (feasts, and Trinity on Sundays "if one will"), Duke Henry's Saxony 1539 ("on the feasts and now and then on Sundays"), Pomerania 1535 ("not always … especially at the high feasts"), the Palatinate 1546 (the whole Preface "on the high feasts", the dialogue always) and the boys' daily service at Hof (from Lossius's book "on the chief festivals") (Sehling 1, pp. 704, 274; 4, p. 341; 14, p. 97; 11, p. 473).
- **Gone.** The *Deutsche Messe* (German Mass), Nürnberg 1533, Albertine Saxony 1580, Württemberg and the Reformed orders. The Palatinate's Reformed form (1563) keeps only the idea of the *Sursum corda*, as an exhortation to lift up the heart "into heaven, where Christ Jesus is" (§2.4.7).

The Mecklenburg rubric shows the whole Preface section made optional. **Mecklenburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1552** (Sehling 5, p. 199):

If then the time permit, the priest may sing the Preface, in German or in Latin, beginning with these words: *Dominus vobiscum*, or "The Lord be with you". And thou findest the Prefaces also set down together hereafter in their place with the customary notes. Thereupon the Sanctus is sung in Latin, as it is also set after the daily Preface, or in German, "Isaiah the prophet, it befell", as it standeth in the song-book. If there be time, the priest may also read to the people an exhortation and instruction concerning the most worthy sacrament, as is also set down after the Prefaces. After the exhortation, or, when for shortness of time the exhortation and Preface are left out, straightway after the sermon, let the priest sing [the Our Father and the Words of the Testament].

2.10.2 Where the Sanctus fell

Five places. The Sanctus is the ordinary that moved most:

1. **After the Preface, before the Verba** (the Roman place): Mecklenburg 1552, Pomerania 1535, Brandenburg 1540, the Palatinate 1546, Transylvania 1547.
2. **After the Verba**, which were sung in the Preface: the *Formula missae* (Form of the Mass; "with the elevation during the Benedictus") and Prussia 1525 (§2.4.4).
3. **After the Verba, without a Preface**: Brandenburg-Nürnberg 1533, followed by the Lord's Prayer and the Pax (§2.4.3).
4. **During the distribution**, in German: the *Deutsche Messe* (German Mass), Duke Henry's Saxony 1539, Albertine Saxony 1580, Mecklenburg 1552 (as an alternative), Hof 1592 (the Latin Sanctus and Agnus "of the season" sung during the communion), Braunschweig-Wolfenbüttel 1543 ("at another time, or at all times, under the communion").
5. **Nowhere**: Württemberg and the Reformed orders.

2.10.3 With or without the Benedictus

The Latin Sanctus kept its Benedictus. Where the Latin Sanctus was sung, it was sung whole, with the *Benedictus qui venit* (Blessed is he that cometh) and its *Hosanna*. The *Formula missae* (Form of the Mass) had the elevation "under the singing of the *Benedictus*" (Sehling 1, p. 6). The Palatinate order of 1546 has the choir sing "the Sanctus as far as the Agnus Dei", that is, through the *Benedictus* (Sehling 14, p. 97), and the Amberg hospital church in 1544 "the Sanctus as far as the Agnus Dei" before the German Lord's Prayer (Sehling 13, p. 283).

Luther's German Sanctus dropped it. "Jesaia dem Propheten" (To Isaiah the prophet) paraphrases Isaiah 6 only, and so has no *Benedictus* and no *Hosanna*. Where it replaced the Latin Sanctus, the *Benedictus* went with it.

The other German Sanctus kept it. The prose German Sanctus of the early German Masses, and the Trinitarian Sanctus of Braunschweig-Wolfenbüttel, keep the *Benedictus* and the Hebrew *Hosianna* (Hosanna):

- Kantz (Nördlingen 1522): "Holy, holy, holy, Lord God Sabaoth; full are heaven and earth of thy glory. Hosanna in the highest! Blessed be he that cometh in the name of the Lord. Luck and salvation in the highest!" (Sehling 12, p. 286), with *Hosanna* rendered "luck and salvation";
- Bremen 1525, in Low German, the same (Sehling 7/2.2, p. 406);
- Braunschweig-Wolfenbüttel 1543: "Holy is God the Father, holy is God the Son, holy is God the Holy Ghost … *Hosianna* in the highest. Blessed be he that cometh in the name of the Lord. *Hosianna* in the highest" (Sehling 6/1, p. 59);
- Dortmund 1554, Low German, with the gloss "*Hosianna* (ah, make us blessed)" (Sehling 21, p. 211);
- the Neuenrade order of 1564 prints two Low German Sanctus texts, both with "Blessed be he that cometh in the name of the Lord" (Sehling 22, p. 532);
- Volprecht and Döber at Nürnberg (1524–1525) rendered *Hosanna* "make us blessed in the highest" (Sehling 11, pp. 41, 54; Chapter 7, §§7.7–7.8).

2.11 The Lord's Prayer and the Words of Institution

The Words of Institution, their wording, their chant and the elevation are treated order by order in Chapter 7; the people's Lord's Prayer hymn in Chapter 8, §8.13. This section compares their order.

Seven sequences.

Sequence	Orders
Preface with Verba → Sanctus → Lord's Prayer → Pax → communion	*Formula missae* 1523; Prussia 1525 (with the Agnus before the Pax)
Exhortation → Verba → Sanctus → Lord's Prayer → Pax → communion	Brandenburg-Nürnberg 1533
Preface → Sanctus → Verba → Lord's Prayer → Pax → Agnus → exhortation → communion	Brandenburg 1540
(Preface → Sanctus →) Lord's Prayer → Verba → communion	Wittenberg 1533; Pomerania 1535; Mecklenburg 1552; Transylvania 1547; Palatinate 1546 (Verba → Pax); Hof 1592 (Lord's Prayer → Pax → Verba)
Paraphrase of the Lord's Prayer + exhortation → Verba → communion	*Deutsche Messe* 1526; Duke Henry's Saxony 1539; Albertine Saxony 1580; Braunschweig-Wolfenbüttel 1543 (at times)
Lord's Prayer hymn → confession → Verba read → communion	Württemberg 1553
Prayer ending in the Lord's Prayer → creed → breaking of bread	Palatinate 1563; Bentheim-Tecklenburg 1588 (both Reformed)

The bread and the cup apart. The *Deutsche Messe* (German Mass) gave the bread after the words over the bread and the cup after the words over the cup. Albertine Saxony (1580) required this "in the villages, where this sacrament is given out by one

person only" (Sehling 1, p. 369), and Prussia (1544) followed it (Sehling 4, pp. 65–66). Elsewhere both words were said or sung before the distribution.

The elevation. Kept with the Verba in the *Formula missae* (Form of the Mass), Prussia 1525, Wittenberg 1533, Brandenburg 1540 and Breslau 1557; abolished in the Palatinate 1546 and in Mecklenburg 1552, "that the inequality bring not contention" (Sehling 5, p. 199). See Chapter 7 and Chapter 12, §12.10.6.

2.12 The Agnus Dei

The German Agnus hymns ("Christe du Lamm Gottes", "O Lamm Gottes unschuldig") and their place after the communion are in Chapter 8, §§8.14–8.15.

2.12.1 How many times

Three, as of old. The Latin Agnus Dei three times, the third ending *dona nobis pacem* (grant us peace), is printed in full in Pfalz-Neuburg 1543 and Brandenburg 1540 (Sehling 13, p. 75; 3, p. 69). Regensburg had the schoolmaster sing it "three times slowly" during the distribution, and more songs if the three were not enough (1542 and 1553: Sehling 13, pp. 393, 420). Luther's German "Christe du Lamm Gottes" (Christ, thou Lamb of God) kept the threefold form: "*Christ, thou Lamb of God … have mercy upon us*. The third time thus: *give us thy peace, amen*" (Wittenberg 1533, Sehling 1, p. 705). Hamburg (1529) and Neuenrade (1564) say the same in Low German (Sehling 5, p. 529; 22, p. 532). Hof sang "O Lamm Gottes unschuldig" (O Lamb of God, innocent) three times, "the last time with these words added: Give us thy peace, O Jesu" (Sehling 11, p. 429). Müntzer's Allstedt (Radical Reformation) order had the people sing the Baptist's witness "three times", the third ending "Give us thy peace" (Sehling 1, p. 506).

Twice. The Prussian order of 1525 cut the Agnus Dei to two, "for brevity's sake", so that the people's hymns during the communion should have more room. **Prussia, *Artikel der ceremonien und anderer kirchen ordnung*, 1525** (Sehling 4, p. 32):

Straightway thereupon the choir singeth the Agnus Dei with few notes, in German or Latin as occasion serveth, yet for brevity's sake only twice, that the Christian songs of the congregation following may have the more room; and to conclude the first time with the *miserere nobis* (have mercy upon us), the second with the *dona nobis pacem*.

The Livonian towns copied it: "the Agnus Dei with few notes, twice … first, *Be gracious to us*; second, *Give us thy peace*" (Wolmar 1533, Sehling 5, p. 16).

Once. The Albertine *Cellische Ordnungen* (Celle orders) of 1545 had the choir sing the Latin Agnus Dei once, after the communion, while the people knelt and gave thanks. **Albertine Saxony, *Die Cellischen Ordnungen*, 1545** (Sehling 1, p. 301):

then shall the choir begin to sing the Latin Agnus Dei only once; meanwhile the people kneel and make their thanksgiving to God.

The single German strophe "Christ, thou Lamb of God … have mercy upon us. Give us thy peace", printed once as the close of the communion, is the form of Duke Henry's Saxony (1539) and the Calenberg-Göttingen Masses (1542) (Sehling 1, p. 275; 6/2, pp. 819, 824), and Kantz's Mass of 1522 has one strophe combining both endings (Sehling 12, p. 286).

2.12.2 Where it fell

Before or during the communion. In the Roman place, before the communion, in Prussia 1525 and Brandenburg 1540; during the distribution in the *Formula missae* (Form of the Mass), Nürnberg 1533, Pomerania 1535, Mecklenburg 1552, Transylvania 1547, Albertine Saxony 1580 and Hof 1592.

After the communion. The German Agnus "Christe du Lamm Gottes" (Christ, thou Lamb of God) after the communion as its close in Wittenberg 1533 ("when the communion is ended"), Hamburg 1529 ("when they have all communicated and are in their places"), Pomerania 1535 and Mecklenburg 1552. Pomerania limits the Latin Agnus and the hymns during the communion: "but not longer than the communion lasteth" (Sehling 4, p. 341).

2.13 The dismissal and the blessing

The Roman Mass ended with *Ite missa est* (Go, it is the dismissal; or *Benedicamus Domino* [Let us bless the Lord] in Masses without the Gloria), and then the priest's blessing, "May almighty God bless you, the Father and the Son and the Holy Ghost", a Trinitarian blessing (Sehling 11, p. 42, note 21). The evangelical orders changed both. The *Benedicamus* in the offices, its seasonal melodies and its German forms are treated in Chapter 8, §§8.16.8–8.16.10; the closing hymns in §8.15 of the same chapter.

2.13.1 *Ite missa est*, *Benedicamus*, or neither

Three practices. A search of every *Ite missa est* (Go, it is the dismissal) and every *Benedicamus* near the end of the Mass gives three practices:

- **The *Ite* kept.** Only two places:
  - the Breslau report of 1557: "with the *Benedicamus* or *Ite missa est* the Mass is closed" (Sehling 3, p. 404);
  - the Brandenburg-Ansbach visitation of 1536, which kept the old order "from the *Confiteor* to the end of the Mass, *Ite missa est*", so far as it was not against Scripture (Sehling 11, p. 326). The Ansbach *Auctuarium* of 1548, an Interim order, then put "the *Benedicamus* for the *Ite missa*" (Sehling 11, p. 327).
- **The *Benedicamus* in its place**, in Latin or in German (lists below).
- **Neither.** Luther's *Deutsche Messe* (German Mass) and most Saxon, Bugenhagen, Upper German and Reformed orders end with the thanksgiving collect and the blessing, and at most a hymn after it. Pomerania (1535): "after the Amen nothing more is sung" (Sehling 4, p. 341).

Never *Ite missa est*. Volprecht's Nürnberg Mass makes the rule explicit. **Nürnberg, *Deutsche Messe* of the Prior Volprecht, 1524** (Sehling 11, p. 39):

The blessing: this is said, and never is *Ite missa est* said; in its place is said *Benedicamus Domino* (Let us bless the Lord); response: *Deo gratias*.

The Latin *Benedicamus*:

- Luther, *Formula missae* (1523): in the place of the *Ite*, "with alleluia added (where and when it pleaseth)", or with the vesper melodies (§2.3.2; Sehling 1, p. 6);
- Nürnberg, *Form und Ordnung einer christlichen Messe* (1525): "*Benedicamus Domino*, *dominicaliter*", then "Es woll uns Gott genädig sein" (May God be gracious to us; Sehling 11, p. 57);
- Goslar (1528): the collect "with the *Benedicamus*" sung by the boys in the choir after the distribution (Sehling 7/2.2, p. 242);
- Brandenburg-Nürnberg (1533), followed by the blessing (quoted below, Sehling 11, p. 198);
- Regensburg (1542): the gospeller sings *Deo dicamus gratias* (Let us say thanks to God); Regensburg (1553): the second minister sings *Benedicamus Domino*, the choir *Deo dicamus gratias* (Sehling 13, pp. 393, 421);
- Pfalz-Neuburg (1543): sung by the priest or the deacons "in the tone in which the Kyrie was sung", the choir answering in the same tone *Deo dicamus gratias* (Sehling 13, p. 76);
- Transylvania (1547): *Dominus vobiscum* (The Lord be with you), collect and *Benedicamus*, all concluded "with the blessing of the people in the name of the Holy Trinity" (Sehling 24, pp. 223, 244);
- Hohenlohe (1553): "the collect with *Benedicamus Domino*", then the Aaronic blessing (Sehling 15, p. 73); the Öhringen foundation (1556) prints its melody with the Mass (Sehling 15, p. 104);
- Suhl in Henneberg (1562): "Collect. *Benedicamus*. The blessing out of Moses" (Sehling 2, p. 351);
- Wolfstein (1574): "the thanksgiving, the *Benedicamus*, the choir answereth *Deo gratias*, and the blessing" (Sehling 13, p. 577);
- Chemnitz (1578): "the collect which is called the *complenda*, and the *Benedicamus* together with the benediction, as is customary" (Sehling 1, p. 542).

The German *Benedicamus*. The early German Masses put the versicle into German, and Hof kept it with its own melody in 1592:

- Müntzer, Allstedt (1524, Radical Reformation): each German Mass ends with a prayer and the *Benedicamus*, "Let us bless the Lord, alleluia. God be thanked for ever" (Sehling 1, pp. 497, 502);
- Erfurt, *Deutsches Kirchenamt* (1525), after Müntzer (Radical Reformation): "Let us bless the Lord. God be thanked for ever", then the Aaronic blessing (Sehling 2, p. 380);
- Lippe (1525), in Low German: "Let us bless the Lord; to God be thanks for ever", then the Aaronic blessing (Sehling 22, p. 569);

- Volprecht's German Mass (1524), after the blessing: "Let us give the Lord praise and thanks! Answer: God be thanked" (Sehling 11, p. 42);
- Worms (1524, Moderate Reformed): "Let us bless God", then a Trinitarian blessing (quoted below);
- Strasbourg (1524, Moderate Reformed): "Give thanks unto the Lord", then the blessing (Sehling 20/1, pp. 133, 139);
- Hof (1592): the deacon "addeth the German *Benedicamus*": "Let us bless the Lord. Chorus: God be thanked", then the Aaronic blessing (Sehling 11, pp. 426–427).

Before or after the blessing. In most orders that kept it the *Benedicamus* came before the blessing, as in the Roman Mass. Brandenburg-Nürnberg 1528 put it after: "for the conclusion the benediction of Numbers 6 in German, thereafter *Benedicamus Domino* sung" (Sehling 11, p. 137). So did Volprecht's German Mass, and Nürnberg 1525, where the *Benedicamus* is followed by a hymn.

2.13.2 The blessing: Aaronic, Trinitarian, or both

Five practices. The blessings at the end of the Mass were searched in every form: Numbers 6, Psalm 67, the Trinitarian formulas ("God the Father, Son and Holy Ghost", "May … bless you, the Father and the Son"), and 2 Corinthians 13:13. They give five practices:

- **The Aaronic blessing alone.** This is the rule, from the *Formula missae* (Form of the Mass) onward. It is in the singular ("The Lord bless thee") in the *Deutsche Messe* (German Mass) and the Saxon orders, and in the plural ("The Lord bless you") in Nürnberg and the south. Examples:
  - Luther's *Deutsche Messe* (1526);
  - Wittenberg (1533);
  - Pomerania (1535);
  - Mecklenburg (1552);
  - Albertine Saxony (1580);
  - Volprecht (1524) and Döber (1525) at Nürnberg;
  - Lippe and Erfurt (1525);
  - Weißenburg and Brandenburg-Nürnberg (1528);
  - Hohenlohe (1553);
  - Suhl (1562);
  - Hof (1592);
  - the Palatinate's Sunday service (1563, Reformed, Sehling 14, p. 391).
- **A Trinitarian blessing alone**: the early German Masses of Worms and Strasbourg (1524, both Moderate Reformed), and Regensburg (1542), all quoted below. Transylvania (1547) blesses "in the name of the Holy Trinity" without printing the words (Sehling 24, p. 223).
- **The Aaronic and the Trinitarian together**, the second following the first: Strasbourg's *Ordenung und inhalt Teutscher Mess* (1524, Moderate Reformed): "The Lord bless you … The blessing of God, the Father and the Son, etc." (Sehling 20/1, p. 140); and the Strasbourg Supper of 1598 (quoted below).
- **A choice of forms**: the Brandenburg-Nürnberg set of four, and its descendants (below).
- **Different blessings for different occasions**: Prussia (1525) and Strasbourg (1598) (below).

The Nürnberg set of four. Brandenburg-Nürnberg gave four blessings to choose from: Numbers 6; a paraphrase of Psalm 67; and two Trinitarian forms. **Brandenburg-Nürnberg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1533** (Sehling 11, p. 198):

Benedicamus Domino. Deo gratias. Thereafter let him bless the people thus: "The Lord bless you and keep you! The Lord make his face shine upon you and be gracious unto you! The Lord lift up his countenance upon you and give you peace! Amen." Or thus: "God be gracious and merciful unto us and give us his divine blessing! May he cause his face to shine upon us and give us his peace! Amen." Or thus: "Bless and keep us, God the Father and the Son and the Holy Ghost! Amen." Or thus: "The blessing of God the Father and of the Son and of the Holy Ghost be with you and abide alway with us all! Amen."

The set passed, whole or shortened, into these orders:

Order	Sehling	Forms offered
Brandenburg-Nürnberg 1533	11, p. 198	Aaronic; Ps 67; "Bless and keep us, God the Father …"; "The blessing of God the Father …"
Pfalz-Neuburg 1543	13, p. 76	the same four
Schwäbisch Hall 1543	17/1, p. 135	Aaronic; the two Trinitarian forms
Strasbourg 1553 (Marbach)	20/1, p. 415	the same four
Württemberg 1553	16, p. 255	Aaronic (singular); Ps 67; "Bless and keep us, God …"
Kurpfalz 1556	14, p. 150	as Württemberg, in the plural
Worms, *Agendbüchlein*, 1560	19/1, p. 210	the same four
Leiningen-Westerburg 1566	19/1, p. 253	Aaronic; Ps 67; "Bless and keep us, God …"
Regensburg 1567	13, p. 463	Aaronic (singular), or "God the Father, God the Son and God the Holy Ghost bless and keep you"
Hanau-Lichtenberg 1573	20/2, p. 67	Aaronic; Ps 67; "Bless and keep us, God …"
Oldenburg 1573	7/2.1, p. 1145	Aaronic (singular); Ps 67; the two Trinitarian forms
Pfalz-Veldenz 1574; Lützelstein 1605	18, pp. 504, 607	Aaronic with "Go forth; the Spirit of the Lord lead you unto eternal life", or "The blessing of God, the Father and the Son and the Holy Ghost … and his Holy Spirit strengthen and preserve us unto eternal life"

A Trinitarian blessing alone. The first German Mass of Worms (Moderate Reformed) closed with a German *Benedicamus* and the Trinitarian blessing only. **Worms, *Deutsche Messe*, 1524** (Moderate Reformed; Sehling 19/1, p. 129):

Let us bless God. Thanks, laud, honour and praise be to God through Christ our Lord, Amen. The blessing: "The blessing of Almighty God, Father, Son and Holy Ghost, be with you and abide alway with you. Amen."

The Nunc dimittis followed. The two Strasbourg Masses of 1524 (Moderate Reformed) by Theobald Schwarz and in the *Teutsche Meß und Tauff* (German Mass and Baptism) end the same way: "The blessing of God, the Father [+] and the Son [+] and the Holy Ghost [+], be with us and abide alway", with three signs of the cross (Sehling 20/1, pp. 123, 133). At Regensburg in 1542 the priest blessed with the Trinitarian form alone. **Regensburg, *Wahrhaftiger Bericht*, 1542** (Sehling 13, p. 393):

Thereafter the priest turneth about toward the people and blesseth them with these words: "Bless and keep us God the Father, Son and Holy Ghost. Amen."

By occasion: feasts and weekdays. Prussia assigned a sung blessing from Psalm 67 to the feasts, and the Aaronic blessing to ordinary days, at the end of matins, vespers and the Mass alike. **Prussia, *Artikel der ceremonien und anderer kirchen ordnung*, 1525** (Sehling 4, pp. 37–38):

There follow the benediction or closing chant at the end of matins, vespers and Mass. On feast days: "God give us his blessing, our God bless us." Response: "And all the ends of the world shall fear him, Amen." The daily benediction: "The Lord make his face shine upon us and be gracious unto us."

By occasion: the sermon and the Supper. Strasbourg in 1598 closed the plain preaching service with the Trinitarian blessing alone, "The blessing of God, the Father, the Son and the Holy Ghost, be now and at all times with us all" (Sehling 20/1, p. 589). It closed the Supper with the Aaronic and the Trinitarian together. **Strasbourg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1598** (Sehling 20/1, p. 613):

"The Lord bless you and keep you. The Lord make his face shine upon you and be gracious unto you. The Lord lift up his countenance upon you and give you peace. The benediction of God, of the Father, of the Son and of the Holy Ghost, be now and at all times with us all, Amen." Go hence in the peace of the Lord.

2 Corinthians 13:13. The apostolic blessing, "The grace of our Lord Jesus Christ and the love of God, together with the communion of the Holy Ghost", appears in two places:

- Hesse (1566, Moderate Reformed) gives it as the alternative to Numbers 6 when the minister dismisses the congregation (Sehling 8, p. 248);
- Nördlingen (1579) closes the pulpit prayers with it (Sehling 12, p. 368).

Psalm 67 stands beside the blessing in three forms:

- Luther's third option in the *Formula missae*;
- the second form of the Nürnberg set;
- the sung feast-day blessing of Prussia.

Where it was sung as Luther's hymn, "Es wolle uns Gott genädig sein" (May God be gracious to us), it closed the service after the blessing: Nürnberg 1525 (Sehling 11, p. 57), Strasbourg 1525 (Moderate Reformed; Sehling 20/1, p. 147), and Hoya 1571, in a service without the Supper (Sehling 6/2, p. 1152; Chapter 8, §8.15).

After the blessing.

- Pomerania (1535) ended there (Sehling 4, p. 341).
- Mecklenburg (1552) added "Erhalt uns, Herr, bei deinem Wort" (Keep us, Lord, by thy word) or "Verleih uns Frieden" (Grant us peace) (Sehling 5, p. 199).
- Duke Henry's Saxony (1539) added "Gott sei gelobet" (God be praised), "and so go home" (Sehling 1, p. 275).

2.14 When nobody communicated

The Mass without the Supper. No evangelical order allowed a Mass without communicants. When nobody had announced himself for the Supper, the Mass stopped after the sermon. What was left was the first half of the ordo, closed with prayers. The postcommunion substitutes and the Litany in this place are treated in Chapter 5, §5.6, and Chapter 13, §13.21; the change of vestments in Chapter 14, §14.7.

The forms.

- **Pomerania 1535**: "everything is sung, as is ordered, until the sermon; but after the sermon one or two German psalms" (Sehling 4, p. 341).
- **Mecklenburg 1552**: confession and absolution; a German psalm or two, or "Allein Gott" (To God alone); collect; epistle; psalm; gospel; *Patrem* (the Nicene Creed); "Wir glauben" (We believe); the sermon with the prayer (Sehling 5, p. 199).
- **Albertine Saxony 1580**: "after the sermon, or a chapter of holy Scripture read, it shall be concluded with a Christian collect and the customary benediction" (Sehling 1, p. 369).
- **Transylvania 1547**: no Mass, but a German psalm, collect, sequence or tract, a chapter of the New Testament in course, "Wir glauben", and the suffrages.

The Transylvanian rubric shows how far the service fell back toward the office. **Transylvania, *Kirchenordnung* (German), 1547** (Sehling 24, p. 244):

But where there are no communicants for this office, no Mass at all is held; but in its stead there is sung first a German psalm, thereupon the collect, further a Christian sequence or tract, or what the season bringeth. Thereafter is read, in order from the beginning of the New Testament to the end, always one chapter in German; only that in Lent the German epistles and gospels are kept, as they are appointed for the days. After the reading of the same chapter is sung "We all believe", with the versicle and collect of the Holy Trinity. Thereafter follow also the other suffrages, namely for the king, for the forgiveness of sins and for peace, with their versicles and collects; which also is concluded with the *Benedicamus* and the blessing of the people.

The boys' daily Mass at Hof. One order kept a Mass-shaped service with no communion at all, as a school exercise. At Hof (1592) the boys' "*actus diurnus*" (daily act) ran: the seasonal Kyrie and *Et in terra* (And on earth) from the great missal; the gospel

in Latin; sequence, tract or gradual; the gospel in German; "the Sanctus of the season", with the Preface on the chief feasts; the Lord's Prayer sung by a boy "in the deacon's place"; "the Agnus Dei of the season"; and a collect (Sehling 11, pp. 472–473).

2.15 Ceremonial: gestures, postures and places

Several gestures are treated elsewhere:

- where the minister stands, and whether he faces the people: Chapter 14, §14.5.2;
- vestments: Chapter 14, §14.7;
- the elevation, the signs of the cross printed over the elements, and the bows of the Latin-frame canons: Chapter 7 (e.g. §§7.12.3, 7.12.8);
- the priest kneeling at the preparation and after the Mass: Chapter 3, §§3.3.2–3.3.4, 3.6.3;
- kneeling during *Veni sancte Spiritus* (Come, Holy Spirit), "Nun bitten wir" (Now pray we) and the hymn in the place of the offertory: Chapter 8, §§8.4.1, 8.11.3, 8.13.2;
- deacons, subdeacons and ministrants at the altar: Chapter 16, §16.4.2.

This section gathers what the orders prescribe for the body during the Mass, gesture by gesture.

2.15.1 What the orders say, and what they do not

The searches. The corpus was searched, near the Mass and the Supper, for each of the following:

- the sign of the cross ("creutz machen", *signum crucis*, "segnen", and the † and [+] marks the editions print in the text);
- genuflection (*genuflexio*, "kniebeugen", *flexis genibus*);
- kneeling, bowing (*inclinatio*, "neigen", "bücken") and standing or sitting;
- hats and bare heads ("hut", "baret", *capite aperto* [with bare head], "bloßes haupt" [bare head]);
- the hands (*manibus iunctis*, *extensis*, "gefaltene hände", "aufgehobene hände");
- turning ("kert sich zum volk", *conversus ad populum*), the sides and horns of the altar (*cornu*, "rechte seite", "epistelseite");
- the kiss and the pax, incense and the washing of hands.

Few rubrics. The orders prescribe little. Where they say anything, it is usually one of three things:

- kneeling, for prayer and for communion;
- turning, toward the altar to pray and toward the people to read, greet and exhort;
- a warning against the old gestures.

Much was left to custom. Nassau (1575, Philippist) keeps "the customary old form of the administration" of the Supper, but drops the "rites and gesticulations" (Sehling 10, p. 151).

Not found. No order in the corpus prescribes any of the following:

- the Roman genuflection on one knee. *Flexis genibus* (On bended knees) and "mit gebogenen knien" (with bent knees) always mean kneeling;
- the epistle and gospel horns of the altar, or carrying the book from one side to the other;
- turning over the right shoulder, or any rule for the direction of a turn;
- the hands of the celebrant joined, raised in the *orans* position, or extended toward the people;
- the kiss of the altar, of the book, of the paten, or of the deacon's hand. Nor are there any honours paid to the deacon;
- the celebrant's biretta, or taking it off and putting it on at the altar;
- incense at the Mass;
- the *Lavabo*.

2.15.2 The sign of the cross

Kept in the early German Masses. The first German Masses still print the crosses:

- **Allstedt** (Radical Reformation). Müntzer's *Ordnung und berechnunge des teutschen ampts* (1523) marks the bread and the cup at the Words of Institution: "blessed † it and brake it", "gesegnete † den" (blessed † it). The minister raises his hand at

"This is my body", and turns to the people with the cup (Sehling 1, p. 506).

- **Strasbourg** (Moderate Reformed). In Schwarz's German Mass of 1524 the places "where the cross is to be made" are marked [+], according to the editors (Sehling 20/1, p. 120). The priest, turned to the people, says "God be gracious and have mercy upon us all [+]" at the beginning. He blesses with three crosses at the end, "The blessing of God, the Father [+] and the Son [+] and the Holy Ghost [+]" (Sehling 20/1, pp. 120, 123). The *Teutsche Meß und Tauff* (German Mass and Baptism) and the *Ordenung und inhalt* (order and content) of 1524 do the same (pp. 130, 133, 137).
- **Hof.** As late as 1592 the order prints a † after the deacon's Pax, "The peace of the Lord be with you all. †", and after the blessing (Sehling 11, pp. 426–427).

The Latin-frame orders keep the signs over the elements at the Verba. They are printed in Chapter 7 with ✠.

Rejected. Hannover (1536) lets go of what is not needful, among it "so many crosses" and "such gestures" (Sehling 6/2, pp. 1007–1008). Danzig (1557), as Sehling quotes it, makes the point at the Words of Institution. **Danzig, first order of the Sunday Mass, 1557** (Sehling 4, p. 168):

The priest taketh the paten with the appointed host into his hand without all papistical crossing and other gestures; so also, when he singeth the words "he took the cup", he taketh the cup into his hand.

Outside the Mass. The sign of the cross stayed in baptism, at the exorcism ("Receive the sign of the holy cross", Luther's *Taufbüchlein* [baptism booklet], Sehling 1, p. 18). It also stayed in the household prayers of the Small Catechism: "In the morning … thou shalt bless thyself with the holy cross and say: The will of God, Father, Son and Holy Ghost be done" (Kurpfalz 1556, Sehling 14, p. 141).

2.15.3 Kneeling, not genuflecting

The priest kneels. The priest kneels at these points:

- for his preparation or *Confiteor* (I confess) at the foot of the altar (Pfalz-Neuburg, Mecklenburg, Regensburg, Hildesheim and others; Chapter 3, §§3.3.2–3.3.4). At Solms (1603) he does so "on the stool" before the altar (Sehling 9, p. 359);
- for the Kyrie and the prayers at Schwäbisch Hall (1535, below);
- through "Nun bitten wir" (Now pray we) at Soest (1609), where the pastor "remains sitting on his knees" (Sehling 22, p. 489);
- after communion. At Hildesheim (1544) he kneels again before the altar and "thanketh God secretly for himself" (Sehling 7/2.1, p. 855). In Mecklenburg (1540/1545) the priest kneels before the altar and "the whole congregation shall do likewise", and they sing "Erhalt uns, Herr, bei deinem Wort" (Keep us, Lord, by thy word; Sehling 5, p. 155).

The congregation kneels. The Brenz order for Schwäbisch Hall makes the whole church kneel at the Kyrie, and says why. **Schwäbisch Hall, *Kirchenordnung*, 1527** (Sehling 17/1, p. 49):

After the psalm the Kyrie eleison shall be sung, as hath been customary. But since it is an earnest, humble prayer, the whole church shall kneel thereto; not that anything toward God lieth in the kneeling, but that there may be a common discipline in the church, and every thing its order.

The Hall draft of 1535 kneels everyone for the Lord's Prayer before the Verba, and lets the pastor alone stand up to say them. **Schwäbisch Hall, draft order of service, 1535** (Sehling 17/1, p. 102):

At the end of the announcement it shall be concluded with an Our Father, which every man shall pray secretly, kneeling down also. After the prayer the pastor alone standeth up and saith the words of consecration, "For in the night in which the LORD," etc., aloud, in German.

Other orders kneel the congregation at these points:

- from the Lord's Prayer to the end of the communion: Hatzkerode (1534): "the whole church shall kneel devoutly until the end of the communion" (Sehling 2, p. 587);
- at the Lord's Prayer of the preparation for the Supper, after the examination and the declaration of forgiveness: the Palatinate (1563, Reformed): "Kneel down and pray, as the Lord hath taught us: Our Father" (Sehling 14, p. 383). The Palatine order of 1601 (Reformed) copied the preparation but struck the kneeling out ("the kneeling at the prayer is struck out", Sehling 14, p. 574);

- at the thanksgiving: Heilbronn (1543): "Kneel down and lift up your hearts unto God" (Sehling 17/1, p. 316); Lützelstein (1605): "Kneel and make the thanksgiving" (Sehling 18, p. 606);
- at the prayers: in the penitential service of Wittgenstein (1555) the ministers kneel and bid the people "also sit upon their knees" (Sehling 22, p. 139); Ulm (1556): the preachers asked that the people, who sat through the common prayer "out of the convenience of the pews", be taught to kneel, "as is customary in other churches" (Sehling 17/2, p. 213);
- in the place of the offertory: Celle (1545) and Anhalt (1548) (Chapter 8, §8.11.3).

Boys kneeling before the altar. The singers of certain pieces knelt:

- *Da pacem* (Give peace), three times, in the Pomeranian Mass (1569, Sehling 4, p. 438);
- "Kom, heiliger Geist" (Come, Holy Ghost) at Corvey's Bruchhausen (1603, Sehling 21, p. 244);
- the litany at Marggrabowa in Prussia (1581, Sehling 4, p. 149);
- *Veni sancte Spiritus* (Come, Holy Spirit) and "Nun bitten wir" at Hof, with the whole choir kneeling (Chapter 8, §8.4.1).

At "and was made man". One custom is reported only later. At Mansfeld, as a memorial against the Flacian error of Cyriacus Spangenberg, four choirboys knelt before the altar during the Creed. They sang alone "is born a true man" and touched the altar steps with their foreheads; the custom lasted into the eighteenth century (Sehling 2, p. 183, after Leopold's chronicle of 1817).

Communicants kneel. Most orders that say how communion was received have the communicants kneel at the altar:

- Regensburg (1542): the men on the right of the altar, the women on the left, "that at the end of the *Patrem* they kneel down there" (Sehling 13, pp. 392–393);
- Hohenlohe (1553): two honourable men set out a silk cloth and "little benches, on which the communicants kneel" (Sehling 15, p. 71);
- Lippe (1566): the men on one side, the women on the other (Sehling 21, p. 388);
- Marienhafe in East Frisia (1593): "kneeling, at one end of the altar or table the blessed bread, at the other the cup" (Sehling 7/1, p. 710);
- Solms (1603): the communicants kneel in the choir while the pastor, turned toward them, reads the exhortation (Sehling 9, p. 361);
- Ermsleben (1564): "they kneel down devoutly; then I pray before them, and they pray after me secretly; thereafter I do the consecration" (Sehling 2, p. 485).

After receiving, the communicants in Bugenhagen's orders went back to their places and "sit on their knees or stand, until the last blessing" (Hamburg 1529, Sehling 5, p. 529; Wolfenbüttel 1543, Sehling 6/1, p. 58).

Standing allowed, sitting forbidden. In Poland the Lutheran, Reformed and Brethren churches of the Sandomierz consensus had to settle the posture together. **Synod of Petrikau, 1–3 June 1578** (Sandomierz consensus; Sehling 4, p. 263):

We grant the ceremonies to Christian liberty, and permit that the godly receive the sacrament of the body and blood of Christ standing or kneeling. But the sitting at the Lord's table, since, besides the rites commonly used in all evangelical churches throughout Europe, those were the first authors of it among us who [...] became faithless deserters from us to Arianism [...] we reject as a ceremony.

The synod of 1583 repeated the rule. Communion was to be given "to those standing or kneeling (with a protestation against the bread-worship customary among the papists)" (Sehling 4, p. 264). The Bohemian Brethren (Hussite) received kneeling. Their *Ordo ecclesiasticus* (Church Order), as Sehling prints it, explains that their forebears had brought in standing in 1494 and gave it up under persecution (Sehling 4, p. 284). In Reformed Emden a Lasco still received kneeling over a towel; the custom was abolished by 1546 at the latest (editors' note, Sehling 7/1, p. 377).

Reverence, not adoration. The Calvinizing Nassau order of 1575 (Philippist) warned the people off the old gestures. **Nassau-Dillenburg, *Agende*, 1575** (Philippist; Sehling 10, p. 151):

Moreover the people shall be exhorted that they show themselves modest and reverent indeed, but not as though they would worship an idol with folded hands and bending of the knee (as is done in the papacy, and some of ours are still wont). After the exhortation "Dearly beloved in God", etc. has been read, the ministers shall remain standing thus with their face turned toward the people.

2.15.4 Bowing

Only in the Latin canons. The bows that survive are the priest's, in the orders that kept a Latin canon:

- Brandenburg (1540) lifts the host "with a slight bow", and has the priest bow for the ablution prayer *Corpus tuum, Domine* (Thy body, O Lord) (*Deinde inclinet se et dicat*) (Sehling 3, pp. 69–70);
- Pfalz-Neuburg (1543) copies the second (Sehling 13, p. 76).

The texts are in Chapter 7, §§7.12.3, 7.12.8.

The name of Jesus. No order prescribes a bow at the name of Jesus. The words of Philippians 2:10, "In the name of Jesus every knee shall bow", are sung as the introit of the Passion Mass by Müntzer (Radical Reformation) and those who copied him (Sehling 1, p. 502; 6/2, p. 825; 2, p. 379), but no rubric turns them into a gesture.

2.15.5 Hats and heads

Men uncovered, women covered. Hesse (Moderate Reformed) puts the old rule of 1 Corinthians 11 into the church order.
Hesse, *Kirchenordnung*, 1566 (Moderate Reformed; Sehling 8, p. 231):

It belongeth also to seemliness and Christian discipline, that in the common assembly of the Christians the women appear with covered head, but the men with bare heads, whereof the apostle Paul [speaketh], 1 Corinthians 11.

A bare head appears elsewhere as a mark of humility:

- the public penitent at Limpurg (1596) sits through the whole sermon "with bare head" on a stool set before the altar or pulpit (Sehling 16, p. 609);
- at an ordination the superintendent lays his hand "on the bare head" of the new pastor (Württemberg 1559, Sehling 16, p. 356).

No order regulates the clergy's caps at the altar. Clerical caps appear only as dress outside the service (Chapter 14, §14.8).

2.15.6 Hands

No rule for the celebrant's hands. The orders say only what the hands hold:

- Müntzer (Radical Reformation): "raising the hand" at the bread (*Elevando manu*), and taking the cup "before the people" (Sehling 1, p. 506);
- Brandenburg (1540): "take the chalice with both hands" (Sehling 3, p. 69);
- Transylvania (1547): the minister, turned to the people, says the Lord's Prayer and then the Verba "from the book over the bread and the wine, holding each in turn in his hands" (*per vices utrunque tenens in manibus*) (Sehling 24, p. 223).

Folded hands. Folded hands appear only for children at the table prayers (Sayn, Solms), and in Nassau's warning against folded hands (1575, Philippist) before the sacrament (above). The laying on of hands belongs to ordination, confirmation, absolution and the reconciliation of penitents, outside the Mass.

2.15.7 Turning: toward the altar, toward the people

The common rule. Where the minister stood at an altar against the wall, the orders turn him to the altar to pray and to the people to read, greet and exhort. Wittenberg (1533) sets the pattern: "the priest readeth a German collect turned toward the altar, and singeth the epistle turned toward the people"; the gospel "turned toward the people", then "again toward the altar" for *Credo in unum Deum* (I believe in one God; Sehling 1, p. 704). Other orders follow it:

- Prussia (1544): "the priest turneth to the people and singeth: Der herre sei mit euch, and turneth again to the altar" for the collect (Sehling 4, p. 66);
- Mecklenburg (1552): the collect "toward the altar", then "he turneth himself again toward the people" for the epistle (Sehling 5, p. 202), followed by Lüneburg (1564, Sehling 6/1, p. 553);
- Schwarzburg (1574): the gospel toward the people, the creed toward the altar (Sehling 2, pp. 132–133);
- Osnabrück (1613): the salutation toward the people, the collect and the thanksgiving toward the altar (Sehling 7/1, pp. 268, 270).

Turned for the Pax. The minister turns to the people for the Pax:

- Regensburg (1542): "he turneth about toward the people and singeth: *Pax vobiscum*" (Sehling 13, p. 393);
- Pfalz-Neuburg (1543): "Thereafter let him turn to the people" (Sehling 13, p. 75);
- Hof (1592): *Diaconus spectans populum* (the deacon facing the people; Sehling 11, p. 426).

Turned for the Verba, or away. The orders divided over the Words of Institution:

- **toward the people:**
  - Müntzer (Radical Reformation; "the minister turning … before the people");
  - Transylvania (*minister conversus ad populum*);
  - Nassau (1575, Philippist, above). Brandenburg (1540) turns to the people for the exhortation and the thanksgiving ("turning to the people", Sehling 3, pp. 69–70);
- **toward the altar:**
  - Limpurg (1610): "he turneth himself toward the altar and saith with distinct voice the words or institution of the Supper" (Sehling 16, p. 620);
  - Sponheim (1607): the minister is to face the people always, "except when, in the action of the Holy Supper, they speak the words of blessing over the elements standing on the altar and pray the Our Father"; then they turn to the altar. But where the altar allows it, he shall stand behind it and say the whole preface, prayer and consecration there, facing the people (Sehling 18, p. 674).

Everything toward the people. Döber's German Mass at the Nürnberg hospital went furthest. **Nürnberg, *Deutsche Messe* of Andreas Döber, 1525** (Sehling 11, p. 51):

First, when the priest cometh to the altar and hath taken the chalice out of the bag, he turneth himself to the people and speaketh aloud as followeth (also all the words that are in the whole Mass), so that he be understood by the hearers.

Heilbronn's draft of 1532 has the minister standing at the altar "by the cross", not in the Mass vestment, turn to the people to read the German collect (Sehling 17/1, p. 301). Hesse (1566, Moderate Reformed) has the collect read "after he hath turned himself to the people" (Sehling 8, p. 239). The visitations that rebuilt altars so that the minister should face the people throughout, and the condemnation of standing behind the table, are in Chapter 14, §14.5.2.

2.15.8 Places at the altar

No horns. The orders do not speak of the epistle and gospel sides. The sides of the altar appear instead as the places of the communicants and of the two elements:

- **Men right, women left.** Regensburg 1542 (above), Wertheim about 1555 (Sehling 11, p. 713), Frankfurt 1530 (Moderate Reformed; Sehling 9, p. 497).
- **Bread at one side, cup at the other.** The orders differ on which side:
  - the Palatinate (1546): the communicants "receive the sacrament of the body of Christ on the left side of the altar, and the sacrament of the blood on the right side" (Sehling 14, p. 97);
  - Hatzkerode (1534) has it the other way round: the body "on the right side from the hand of the pastor", the blood "on the left side from the deacon", with silk cloths held under on both sides (Sehling 2, p. 587);
  - Neckarbischofsheim (1560): the communicants "go round the altar on the right side to the pastor, to receive the blood of the Lord" (Sehling 16, p. 684);
  - Marienhafe 1593: bread at one end, cup at the other (above).
- **At the cross-altar.** Heilbronn (1530): after the creed "the preacher turneth over the cross altar with his two deacons in surplices toward the people" and proclaims the Lord's death (Sehling 17/1, p. 285).

2.15.9 The Peace, the kiss and incense

The kiss of peace replaced by a reading. Luther made the Pax an absolution (§2.8). Strasbourg (Moderate Reformed) replaced the kiss with a text. **Strasbourg, *Gottesdienstordnung*, 1542** (Moderate Reformed; Sehling 20/1, p. 330):

Then, since among the ancients at the distribution of the Lord's Supper the kiss of peace was in use as a sign of mutual reconciliation, let the minister in the stead of it read some text of brotherly reconciliation, admonishing [them].

No order keeps a pax-board.

Incense. None of the orders prescribes incense at the Mass:

- the *Formula missae* (Form of the Mass) leaves lights and incense at the gospel free (Sehling 1, p. 5);
- Hannover (1536) lets go of "censing" with the other unneeded gestures (Sehling 6/2, p. 1007).

Ablutions. In the sick communion of Brandenburg (1540) and Pfalz-Neuburg (1543) the priest rinses his fingers over the chalice and gives the ablution to the sick person (Sehling 3, p. 80; 13, p. 88). The Latin ablution prayers of the Mass are in Chapter 7, §7.12.8.

2.15.10 Summary

Gesture	Prescribed	Rejected or absent
Sign of the cross	over bread and cup (Allstedt 1523, Radical Reformation); at the greeting and blessing (Strasbourg 1524, Moderate Reformed); at the Pax and blessing (Hof 1592); over the elements in the Latin canons	"so many crosses" let go (Hannover 1536); "without all papistical crossing" (Danzig 1557); "rites and gesticulations" avoided (Nassau 1575, Philippist)
Genuflection	none	*flexis genibus* (on bended knees) means kneeling
Kneeling	priest at the preparation, the Kyrie and after communion; people at the Kyrie (Hall 1527), the Lord's Prayer (Hall 1535, Palatinate 1563 (Reformed)), the whole communion (Hatzkerode 1534), the thanksgiving (Heilbronn 1543, Lützelstein 1605); communicants at the altar; boys at *Da pacem* (Give peace), the litany, *Veni sancte*	folded hands and kneeling "as to an idol" (Nassau 1575, Philippist); kneeling at prayer struck out (Palatinate 1601, Reformed); sitting at communion forbidden (Petrikau 1578)
Bowing	at the elevation and the ablution prayer (Brandenburg 1540, Pfalz-Neuburg 1543); boys' foreheads to the step at "born man" (Mansfeld, later report)	no bow at the name of Jesus
Head	men bareheaded, women covered (Hesse 1566, Moderate Reformed)	no rubric for the celebrant's cap
Hands	raise the hand at the bread (Allstedt, Radical Reformation); the chalice with both hands (Brandenburg); bread and cup held in turn (Transylvania)	no *orans*, joined hands or extended hands
Turning	to the altar for collects and creed, to the people for readings, salutation, Pax and exhortation (Wittenberg 1533 and most); everything toward the people (Döber 1525)	no direction of turn, no right shoulder
Places	men right, women left; bread and cup at two sides or ends	no epistle or gospel horn
Kiss	a text on reconciliation in its place (Strasbourg 1542, Moderate Reformed)	no kiss of altar, book or deacon; no pax-board
Incense	free at the gospel (*Formula missae*)	"censing" let go (Hannover 1536); prescribed nowhere

2.16 Concordance of the orders quoted

The concordance. Every order quoted in a block quotation is listed below in date order, with the volume and pages of Sehling, the `eko.db` document that holds the text, and the sections where it is quoted. Orders cited only in the text and tables can be found through the table in §2.5 and the section on each ordinary.

Order	Sehling	Doc	Quoted in §
Wittenberg, Luther, *Formula missae*, 1523	1, pp. 5, 6	2	2.3.2

Order	Sehling	Doc	Quoted in §
Nürnberg, *Deutsche Messe* of the Prior Volprecht, 1524	11, p. 39	247	2.13.1
Strasbourg, *Ordenung und inhalt Teutscher Mess*, 1524 (Moderate Reformed)	20/1, p. 138	1279	2.9.4
Worms, *Deutsche Messe*, 1524 (Moderate Reformed)	19/1, p. 129	1066	2.13.2
Nürnberg, *Deutsche Messe* of Andreas Döber, 1525	11, p. 51	249	2.15.7
Prussia, *Artikel der ceremonien und anderer kirchen ordnung*, 1525	4, pp. 32, 37–38	1832, 1833	2.4.4, 2.6.3, 2.12.1, 2.13.2
Wittenberg, Luther, *Deutsche Messe und ordnung gottis diensts*, 1526	1, p. 14	3	2.3.3
Schwäbisch Hall, *Kirchenordnung*, 1527	17/1, p. 49	755	2.15.3
Brandenburg-Nürnberg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1533	11, pp. 196–197, 198	270	2.4.3, 2.13.2
Wittenberg, *Kirchen-Ordnung für die Stadt Wittenberg*, 1533	1, p. 704	148	2.7.1, 2.9.1
Pomerania, *Kirchenordnung*, 1535	4, p. 341	1856	2.4.2
Schwäbisch Hall, draft order of service, 1535	17/1, p. 102	760	2.15.3
Pomerania, *Kirchenordnung*, 1542	4, p. 356	1859	2.6.2
Regensburg, *Wahrhaftiger Bericht*, 1542	13, p. 393	432	2.13.2
Strasbourg, *Gottesdienstordnung*, 1542 (Moderate Reformed)	20/1, p. 330	1311	2.15.9
Braunschweig-Wolfenbüttel, *Christlike kerken-ordeninge*, 1543	6/1, pp. 54, 55	1972	2.6.1, 2.7.2
Albertine Saxony, *Die Cellischen Ordnungen*, 1545	1, p. 301	33	2.12.1
Palatinate, *Gemaine maß, die kirchen- und gottesdinst anzurichten*, 1546	14, pp. 96–97	472	2.4.5
Transylvania, *Kirchenordnung* (German), 1547	24, p. 244	1669	2.14
Mecklenburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1552	5, p. 199	1922	2.10.1
Danzig, first order of the Sunday Mass, 1557	4, p. 168	1844	2.15.2
Palatinate, *Kirchenordnung*, 1563 (Reformed)	14, p. 386	504	2.4.7
Hesse, *Kirchenordnung*, 1566 (Moderate Reformed)	8, pp. 231, 242–243	2257	2.9.2, 2.15.5
Hesse, *Agende*, 1574 (Philippist)	8, p. 411	2272	2.9.4
Nassau-Dillenburg, *Agende*, 1575 (Philippist)	10, p. 151	182	2.15.3
Synod of Petrikau, 1–3 June 1578 (Sandomierz consensus)	4, p. 263	1846	2.15.3
Hof, *Ordo ecclesiasticus*, 1592	11, p. 472	294	2.6.2
Strasbourg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1598	20/1, p. 613	1344	2.13.2
Rothenberg, *Christliche vereinigung* of the ministers, 1618	13, p. 548	460	2.9.4

Chapter 3. Mass Preliminaries

This chapter covers the parts of the evangelical Mass that are neither Ordinary nor Proper, in the church orders of the sixteenth century printed in Emil Sehling's *Die evangelischen Kirchenordnungen des XVI. Jahrhunderts* (The Evangelical Church Orders of the Sixteenth Century). It asks:

- **Opening versicles and preliminaries.** What stood before the Introit, and into what families do the orders fall?
- **The exhortation.** Where does the exhortation to the communicants fall, and what does it say?
- **The *Confiteor*, *Misereatur*, *Indulgentiam* and absolution.** Where are they? Does the priest say them alone, with his ministrants or sexton, or with the people? Are they said privately before Mass, at the beginning of Mass, or in the communion rite? Are the old texts kept or new ones written? Is the absolution optative, declaratory or indicative, and how does it compare with the modern Common Service?
- **Before and after the service.** Do the vesting prayers survive? Are the *Benedicite* (Bless ye) and Ps 150 appointed after Mass, and who says them? Are there prayers before and after the sermon, on entering or leaving church, or for the communicants?

How the chapter is laid out.

- §3.1 summarizes the findings, and §3.2 sets out the scope and sources.
- §3.3 covers the opening versicles and preliminaries, by family.
- §3.4 covers the confession and absolution: placement, the chancel party, old and new texts, the form of the absolution, and the descent of the Common Service's confession.
- §3.5 covers the exhortation to the communicants: where it falls, and the families of text, each collated against its archetype, which is printed in full with a translation.
- §3.6 covers what comes before and after the service: vesting, the priest's private prayers, the *Benedicite* and Ps 150, prayers about the sermon, and prayers on entering church and at communion.
- §3.7 is a table by order, and §3.8 a concordance of every order quoted.

The Canon, the Words of Institution and the prayers around communion are treated in Chapter 7. Several texts printed there are only cross-referenced here: Kantz 1522, Döber's exhortation, the Kiel Mass and Bugenhagen's preparatory prayer.

Related chapters. Several subjects are treated more fully elsewhere and are only cited here:

- the whole order of the Mass, and where the preliminaries fall in it: Chapter 2, §§2.4–2.5;
- private confession and absolution, and the examination of communicants: Chapter 13, §13.17;
- the hymns at the opening of the service: Chapter 8, §8.4;
- the prayers and notices around the sermon: Chapter 11, §11.10;
- confession and communion as duties of the laity: Chapter 15, §15.8.3;
- fasting before communion: Chapter 12, §12.13.6;
- vestments: Chapter 14, §14.7.

3.1 Summary of findings

1. **The Roman preparation was broken up.** No evangelical order keeps the whole of the priest's preparation: *Introibo* (I will go in), Ps 43 *Iudica me* (Judge me), *Confiteor* (I confess), *Misereatur* (May [almighty God] have mercy), *Indulgentiam* (Pardon) and *Aufer a nobis* (Take away from us). The one order that keeps most of it is Müntzer's Allstedt Mass (1523/1524; Radical Reformation): Ps 43 said by priest and people, then the *Confiteor*, the *Misereatur*, *Deus, tu conversus* (O God, thou wilt turn again) and *Aufer a nobis*, all in German and aloud; *Introibo* survives there only as a verse of the psalm (§3.3.8). Elsewhere *Iudica me* disappears, and *Aufer a nobis* survives only in the *Cellische Ordnungen* (Celle orders) of 1545 (after the sermon) and, on the editor's reading, at Regensburg 1542. *Adiutorium nostrum* (Our help; Ps 124:8) is the one versicle that survives widely. The German missals' *Confitemini Domino quoniam bonus* (O give thanks unto the Lord, for he is good) survives in Döber and Mecklenburg 1540 (§3.3.1).

2. **The preliminaries fall into seven families** (§3.3.1):

    - **A.** The priest's private *Confiteor* at the altar during the Introit (Brandenburg-Nürnberg, Brandenburg, Pfalz-Neuburg, Hohenlohe, Regensburg, Amberg, Buxtehude, Bergedorf, Schleswig-Holstein).

- **B.** Bugenhagen's kneeling prayer with the sexton: the Our Father and *Domine, non secundum* (O Lord, deal not with us; Wolfenbüttel, Hildesheim).
- **C.** The public confession of Döber (Nürnberg 1525), carried north to Lippe, Kiel and Mecklenburg and back south to Amberg, Pfalz-Zweibrücken and Pfalz-Veldenz. Amberg 1555 puts the confession in the plural, "We poor sinful men" (§3.3.4).
- **D.** The medieval *Offene Schuld* (open confession) of the preaching service moved into the Mass (Kantz, Bremen 1525, Volprecht, Naumburg, Nördlingen).
- **E.** The Strasbourg and Reformed opening: confession and comfortable word (Strasbourg 1537, Moderate Reformed; Palatinate 1563, Reformed).
- **F.** A hymn, a German psalm, or *Veni Sancte Spiritus* (Come, Holy Spirit) with its versicle and collect, the last a recasting of the medieval *accessus* as a preparation of the congregation (Luther 1526, Amberg 1544, Verden 1606, Transylvania 1547).
- **G.** Müntzer's German *Stufengebet* (prayers at the foot of the altar) at Allstedt (Radical Reformation), with Ps 43 said by priest and people (§3.3.8).

3. **The confession stands in four places** (§3.4.1): privately before the Introit; publicly before the Introit; after the sermon (Bugenhagen 1528, Amberg 1550, the Palatinate); and in the communion rite after the exhortation (Kantz, Württemberg 1536, Nürnberg after 1569). Mecklenburg 1552 and Nördlingen 1544 have it twice.

4. **The chancel party** (§3.4.2):

   - **Families A and B.** The priest prays alone or with his ministrants (Brandenburg 1540, Pfalz-Neuburg), or with the second ministrant in dialogue (Regensburg). In the north the sexton is the server: he kneels with the priest (Bugenhagen, Mecklenburg 1540), says the *Misereatur* (Kiel), or reads the absolution (Kiel, Hadeln).
   - **Family C.** In Mecklenburg 1552 and Pfalz-Zweibrücken 1557 "another minister or the custos" kneels beside the priest and says the prayer for forgiveness, and the choir answers the versicle.
   - **The people** keep silence and confess in their hearts (Mecklenburg), repeat the words after the priest (Döber, Bugenhagen's pulpit confession, Amberg's weekday prayer), or answer "Yes" (Palatinate 1563, Reformed).

5. **Before Mass.** The priest's *Confiteor* is said at the altar, not in the sacristy. The communicant's real preparation is private confession on the Saturday or before the service. The Brandenburg and Pfalz-Neuburg orders forbid a "gemeine beicht" (common confession) in its place (§3.4.6).

6. **No Roman text is kept in public.** The Latin *Confiteor* survives only as the priest's private prayer, unprinted (Hohenlohe: "the pure Confiteor in Latin"). Every public confession is a new text, in five families of wording (§3.4.3). The *Misereatur* survives by name at Kiel; as a prayer for "us" in Döber; and as the second minister's collect in Mecklenburg 1552. The *Indulgentiam* survives in Kantz's "The almighty, merciful God forgive you your sins!" and in Döber's "The almighty, merciful God hath had mercy upon us".

7. **Five kinds of absolution** (§3.4.4):

   - **optative** ("vouchsafe to have mercy upon us");
   - **declaration of grace** in the first person plural ("hath had mercy upon us … God grant this unto us all");
   - **indicative** ("I declare you free, quit and loosed"; "I forgive you"; "I loose you");
   - **conditional declaration** with retention (Strasbourg 1537, Moderate Reformed; Palatinate 1563, Reformed);
   - **none**, only a word of comfort (Bugenhagen 1528).

   At the beginning of Mass the declaration of grace prevails; in the communion rite, the indicative.

8. **The Common Service descends from Mecklenburg** (§3.4.5). The Common Service's preparation is Döber's 1525 sequence by way of Mecklenburg 1552 and Pfalz-Zweibrücken 1557. That sequence is the address "Beloved in the Lord", *Adiutorium* (Our help), the confession "by nature sinful and unclean", the prayer "O most merciful God", and the declaration "Almighty God … hath had mercy upon us … Grant this, O Lord, unto us all". The prayer "O most merciful God" was the second minister's *Misereatur*; the declaration is a declaration of grace, not an indicative absolution. The indicative form of later American books ("Upon this your confession … I forgive you all your sins") has its counterpart in Naumburg 1537.

9. **The exhortation** (§3.5) falls in six places:
    - after the sermon, from the pulpit or altar (Luther 1526, left free);
    - at the altar before the Verba (Brandenburg-Nürnberg 1533, moved there at Luther's suggestion; Württemberg; the Palatinate 1563, Reformed);
    - before the Preface, as the "true Preface" (Bugenhagen);
    - after the Preface and Sanctus (Mecklenburg 1552; Naumburg 1537 before the Sanctus);
    - after the Verba and Our Father (Nürnberg 1524–1525, Osiander's original place);
    - after communion (Memmingen 1528, Moderate Reformed; Marienhafe 1593).

    There are eleven families of text, each collated word by word against its archetype (§3.5.2): Luther 1526; Osiander 1524, with the Braunschweig recension of the north; Brandenburg-Nürnberg 1533; Württemberg 1536, revised 1553; Bugenhagen 1528, in Low and High German; Naumburg 1537; Mecklenburg 1552, which contains an absolution; the Palatinate 1563 (Reformed), with its Lower Rhine recension (Reformed); Pfalz-Veldenz 1574; the Basel text (Reformed) of Memmingen 1528 (Moderate Reformed) and Neckarbischofsheim 1560; and Strasbourg 1525 (Moderate Reformed). Augsburg 1530 (Moderate Reformed), Buxtehude 1565 and Micron (Reformed) each have an exhortation of their own (§3.5.14). Every archetype is given in full with a translation.

10. **No vesting prayers** (§3.6.1). None of the prayers in the Lutheran Missal Project's *Vesting Prayers* occurs in any order: the preparatory psalms, the antiphon *Ne reminiscaris* (Remember not), the *preces* and collects, and the prayers at the washing of hands and at each vestment. Vestments are "indifferent". The priest vests in silence, at Hadeln during the *Te Deum* (We praise thee, O God) "not as needful". The *Stufengebet* alone of the medieval priest's three preparations survives. The *accessus* survives only as the congregation's *Veni Sancte Spiritus*.

11. **After Mass** (§3.6.3). The *Benedicite* (Bless ye) and Ps 150 are never appointed after Mass. They occur only as the canticle and psalms of Sunday Lauds, sung by the schoolboys under the cantor or by the canons (Pomerania 1535, Schleswig-Holstein 1542, Ansbach 1533). The priest's private thanksgiving survives only at Hildesheim 1544 and in Schleswig-Holstein 1542: he unvests during the closing hymn, kneels, and "thanketh God secretly for himself", with no text given.

12. **Sermon, church door and communion** (§§3.6.4–3.6.5):
    - The sermon is framed by a bidding to prayer, the Our Father or a hymn of the Holy Ghost, and the general prayer after it. All are led by the preacher, with the people praying and the schoolboys singing.
    - No order prints a prayer for the worshipper on entering or leaving church, or private prayers for the communicant. Their place is taken by the opening hymn "when one cometh into the church" (Sayn 1590), the prayers the minister says for the communicants (Pfalz-Veldenz 1574), and the hymns during the distribution.
    - The nearest thing to a hymnal devotion is the Pfalz-Zweibrücken *Gesangbuch* (hymnal) of 1571/1587, which prints the Mecklenburg confession and absolution for the people's use "before the sermon on Sunday".

3.2 Scope, sources and method

Scope. The chapter covers the evangelical (Lutheran, Upper German and Reformed) orders printed in Sehling's volumes 1–24. It deals with what the orders set before the Introit, the confession and absolution wherever they fall, the exhortation to the communicants, and the prayers before and after the service. It does not treat:

- the Ordinary and Propers (see Chapter 4);
- the collects (see Chapter 5);
- the general prayer (see Chapter 6);
- the Canon and the communion devotions (see Chapter 7);
- private confession (see Chapter 13 §13.17).

Sources. The quotations come from the `eko.db` database. Candidate passages were found by searching the whole corpus for:

- the Latin incipits *Confiteor* (I confess), *Misereatur* (May [almighty God] have mercy), *Indulgentiam* (Pardon), *Introibo* (I will go in), *Adiutorium* (Our help), *Confitemini* (O give thanks), *Ne reminiscaris* (Remember not), *Quam dilecta* (How amiable), *Benedicite* (Bless ye) and *Laudate*;

- the German and Low German words for open confession and absolution (*offene beicht*, *offene schuld*, *gemeine beicht*, *bicht*, *absolutio*);
- the words for the exhortation (*vermanung*, *vormaninge*, *exhortatio*, *ermanung*), together with the address formulas ("Mein allerliebsten", "Lieben freunde", "Myne allerlevesten", "Ir geliebten");
- the words for vesting, the sacristy and the preparation (*ornat*, *messgewand*, *angekledet*, *praeparatio ad missam*, *Rüsthandlung*);
- prayers before and after the sermon, on entering church, and before and after communion.

Each hit was read in context. Editor's notes that identify a source or a medieval model are quoted where they bear on the question.

Method and limits.

- **Pages.** Each order is cited by Sehling's running head. Pages were checked against the page markers in the database.
- **Dates.** Some orders are dated differently in the database's record headings. Hadeln is printed by Sehling as the "Hadelner Kirchenordnung von 1526" (Hadeln church order of 1526) within a record headed 1590. Verden's order is the *Kirchenordnung* (church order) of 1606 within a record headed 1612. Döber's Mass of 1525 lies within the record of the Nürnberg parish churches of 1524.
- **Coverage.** The exhortations were found by scanning every document in the corpus for wording shared with a known exhortation, and every witness found was collated against the archetype of its family (§3.5.2).
- **Negative findings.** That a form "does not occur" (vesting prayers, *Ne reminiscaris*, prayers on entering church) means that searches of the whole corpus for its Latin incipits and German equivalents found nothing. OCR damage can hide a passage, so such findings are strong but not absolute.

3.3 Opening versicles and preliminaries

3.3.1 What the Roman Mass had, and what became of it

The medieval preparation. Before the Introit, the Roman Mass of the later Middle Ages had three layers of preparation for the priest:

1. **The *accessus*** (Akzess): a private office of psalms and prayers said before Mass.
2. **The *praeparatio ad missam*** in the sacristy: the washing of hands and a prayer at the putting on of each vestment.
3. **The prayers at the foot of the altar** (*Stufengebet*), said by the priest and server in dialogue:
    - the invocation, and *Introibo ad altare Dei* (I will go in unto the altar of God) with Ps 43 *Iudica me* (Judge me);
    - *Adiutorium nostrum in nomine Domini* (Our help is in the name of the Lord; Ps 124:8);
    - the *Confiteor* (I confess), said first by the priest and then by the server;
    - the *Misereatur* ("May almighty God have mercy upon thee …"), said by each for the other;
    - the *Indulgentiam* ("May the almighty and merciful Lord grant us pardon, absolution and remission of our sins");
    - the versicles *Deus, tu conversus* (O God, thou wilt turn again), and the prayers *Aufer a nobis* (Take away from us) and *Oramus te* (We pray thee).

Many German diocesan missals also had the versicle *Confitemini Domino quoniam bonus* (O give thanks unto the Lord, for he is good) / *Quoniam in saeculum misericordia eius* (For his mercy endureth for ever; Ps 118:1) before the *Confiteor*.

What became of it. No evangelical order in Sehling keeps the whole of this. One order keeps a large part of it: Thomas Müntzer's German Mass for Allstedt (1523, printed 1524; Radical Reformation). There Ps 43 *Iudica me* is said by the priest and the whole people, and is followed by German forms of the *Confiteor*, the *Misereatur*, *Deus, tu conversus* and *Aufer a nobis*. *Introibo ad altare Dei* survives there only as the fourth verse of the psalm, not as an antiphon (§3.3.8). Elsewhere only fragments remain:

- *Aufer a nobis* is sung in Latin after the sermon in the *Cellische Ordnungen* (Celle orders) of 1545, and Sehling's editor takes the collect after the *Confiteor* at Regensburg 1542 to be the same prayer (§3.3.8).
- The Mass form of the *Confiteor* is said by the priest with a deacon or fellow minister at Regensburg 1542 and Nördlingen 1544 (§3.3.2, §3.3.8).
- Sehling's editor prints the Bremen missal's *Stufengebet*, with *Introibo* (I will go in) and *Iudica*, as the background to the pastor's kneeling prayer at Buxtehude and Bergedorf (§3.3.2).

What survives falls into the families set out below:

Family	Form	Who says it	Where	Orders (§)
A	The priest's own *Confiteor* (or "what his devotion bids") at the altar, while the choir sings the Introit	The priest, sometimes with a ministrant or a fellow minister	Before or during the Introit	Brandenburg-Nürnberg 1533, Brandenburg 1540, Pfalz-Neuburg 1543, Hohenlohe 1553, Regensburg 1553, Amberg 1550, Buxtehude 1552, Nördlingen 1544, Schleswig-Holstein 1542 (3.3.2)
B	Bugenhagen's kneeling prayer: Our Father and the tract *Domine, non secundum* (O Lord, deal not with us)	The priest and the sexton, alternately	During the opening psalm	Wolfenbüttel 1543, Hildesheim 1544 (3.3.3)
C	A public confession in the people's hearing, with *Adiutorium* (Our help) and *Confitemini* (O give thanks), a recast *Misereatur* and a declaration of grace	The priest kneeling, with the sexton or a second minister; the people silently or repeating	At the very beginning of Mass	Döber 1525, Lippe [1525–1538], Kiel [after 1526], Mecklenburg 1540 and 1552, Amberg 1555, Pfalz-Zweibrücken 1557, Pfalz-Veldenz 1574, Hadeln (3.3.4)
D	The *Offene Schuld* (open confession) moved into the Mass, with an indicative absolution	The priest to the people	Before the Introit, or before the Sacrament	Kantz 1522, Bremen 1525, Volprecht 1524, Naumburg 1537, Nördlingen 1544 (3.3.5)
E	The Upper German and Reformed opening of the preaching service: confession of sins and a comfortable word	The minister for the congregation	At the beginning of the service, or after the sermon	Strasbourg 1537 (Moderate Reformed), Palatinate 1563 (Reformed), Wertheim 1524 (3.6; and §3.4)
F	A hymn, a German psalm, or *Veni Sancte Spiritus* (Come, Holy Spirit) with its versicle and collect	Choir, schoolboys or congregation; the priest the collect	Before the Introit	Luther 1526, Amberg 1544, Verden 1606, Transylvania 1547, Buxtehude 1552, Mecklenburg villages, Sayn 1590 (3.3.7)
G	Ps 43 *Iudica me*, the *Confiteor*, the *Misereatur*, *Deus, tu conversus* and *Aufer a nobis*, in German	The priest and the whole people	Before the Introit	Müntzer, Allstedt 1523 and 1524 (Radical Reformation) (3.3.8)

The versicles that survive.

- *Adiutorium nostrum* (Our help; Ps 124:8) is the one Roman versicle that survives widely: Kantz 1522, Döber 1525, Lippe, Mecklenburg 1540 and 1552, Pfalz-Zweibrücken 1557 and Poullain's French liturgy at Frankfurt (Reformed; Sehling 9, p. 563) all have it.
- *Confitemini Domino quoniam bonus* (Ps 118:1) survives in Döber, Lippe and Mecklenburg 1540, but is dropped in Mecklenburg 1552.
- In Verden 1606 the versicle is *Emitte Spiritum tuum* (Send forth thy Spirit; Ps 104:30), which belongs with *Veni Sancte Spiritus*.

3.3.2 Family A: the priest's own *Confiteor* at the altar

The commonest form in the south and in Brandenburg is a private preparation of the priest. He comes to the altar in his vestments, kneels and says the *Confiteor* (I confess) or some other prayer of his own while the choir sings the Introit. The people

take no part, and the text is not printed. The model is the Brandenburg-Nürnberg order. **Brandenburg-Nürnberg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1533** (Sehling 11, p. 188):

Order of the Mass, how the same shall be held. First, when the priest cometh to the altar, he may say the Confiteor, or what his devotion putteth him in mind of, and thereafter read the Introit, provided that it be taken out of the holy Scripture. Meanwhile the scholars, where there is a school, shall also sing the Introit in Latin. But where, as in villages, there were not people for such Latin singing, a Christian German hymn shall be sung, according to the occasion of each place.

The Mark Brandenburg adds the ministrants. **Brandenburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1540** (Sehling 3, pp. 67–68):

First, the priest that holdeth the Mass, together with his ministrants, in their accustomed church ornaments, according to the custom of each church, shall go to the altar and at the beginning say the Confiteor. Thereafter shall be sung the accustomed Introit, then the Kyrie eleison, as occasion serveth, and upon that the Gloria in excelsis, which together with the Et in terra belongeth to the Kyrie.

Pfalz-Neuburg copies Brandenburg, but makes the priest kneel and allows a penitential psalm instead. **Pfalz-Neuburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1543** (Sehling 13, p. 70):

First, the priest that will hold the Mass, together with his ministrants (where and when they are wont to be used), shall go to the altar in their accustomed church ornaments, according to the custom of each church, and at the beginning, kneeling before it, say the Confiteor or a goodly penitential psalm.

Hohenlohe insists on the Latin text of the Missal. **Hohenlohe, *Kirchenordnung*, 1553** (Sehling 15, p. 68):

First, the parson shall come before the altar in his ornament and church vesture, kneel down, and pray the pure Confiteor in Latin. Meanwhile the schoolmaster with the scholars shall sing the Introit *de tempore* (of the season) in Latin, but only those that are agreeable to the holy Scripture.

Editor's note (p. 68). "The Confiteor is the confession of sins that is part of the prayers at the foot of the altar. Here the piece from the Mass itself is meant, whereas the Brandenburg-Nürnberg order of 1533 required only a corresponding piece." What "pure" is meant to exclude is not said; presumably the invocation of the Virgin and the saints.

At Regensburg the *Confiteor* is said in dialogue with the second of two ministrants. **Regensburg, *Kirchenordnung* under Justus Jonas, 1553** (Sehling 13, pp. 419–420):

then cometh the priest (that is, the minister who, as is said above, is hebdomadary) together with two ministrants or deacons before the altar, and prayeth thus with the one ministrant (who is for that time the second) the Confiteor kneeling. Meanwhile the choir singeth the Introit *de tempore* in Latin and the Kyrie eleison three times.

At Amberg the choir sings an antiphon of the season or *Veni Sancte* (Come, Holy [Spirit]) over the priest's *Confiteor*, and the priest then sings a collect. **Amberg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1550** (Sehling 13, p. 285):

The Mass is held with us almost throughout as it hath come down of old, with the accustomed vesture, lights, chants and other ornaments, most seemly; for first the priest prayeth the Confiteor kneeling before the altar. During this the choir singeth *Haec est dies* (This is the day) or *Veni Sancte*, and the priest thereupon *Oremus* and the collect. Thereupon the choir singeth the Introit of the Sunday and of the ordinary feasts that fall.

Editor's note (p. 285): "Probably not the *Confiteor* of the Mass said in alternation with the ministrant, but, as also in 1533, a silent prayer."

In the north the same private prayer appears at Buxtehude. **Buxtehude, *Kirchenordnung*, 1552** (Sehling 7/1, p. 74):

During the Introit the priest, clad in the accustomed Mass vestment, shall go before the altar and at the altar's foot make his prayer and confession.

Sehling's editor sets this against the Bremen missal of 1511. **Buxtehude, *Kirchenordnung*, 1552, editor's note** (Sehling 7/1, p. 74):

The pastor's prayer at the foot of the altar, appointed there before the Introit because the pastor must sing the Introit with [the choir], is mentioned by Aepinus in his Bergedorf church order of 1544. […] The prayers at the foot of the altar according to the

Bremen missal of 1511: Before the altar let the priest say: *Introibo ad altare Dei* (I will go in unto the altar of God) [Psalm 43:4]. The psalm *Iudica me Deus* (Judge me, O God) [Psalm 43], etc. Then let him say the confession. *Et introibo* (And I will go in), etc.

The Bergedorf order to which the note refers has the same private prayer, before the opening psalm or Introit. **Bergedorf, *Kirchenordnung*, 1544** (Sehling 5, p. 387):

In the Mass this order shall be kept. The pastor, clad in the accustomed Mass vestment or clothes, shall first kneel down at the foot before the altar and make his prayer to God; when he standeth up, he shall begin and sing with a German psalm, or on the feasts with a Latin Introit of the Trinity or of the Holy Ghost (if he have help, that can also sing).

Neither order says what the prayer is. Nothing in Sehling shows that *Introibo* (I will go in) and *Iudica* were said there; the editor gives the missal's form for comparison.

In Schleswig-Holstein 1542 the priest falls on his knees before the altar and reads the *Confiteor* "to himself", with an intercession for the preachers, the king and the duchies (Sehling 23, p. 89; quoted in full in Chapter 7 §7.15.3).

Nördlingen 1544: the private and the public confession side by side. Kaspar Löner's order keeps both. The celebrant first receives absolution from a fellow minister on his own *Confiteor*, while two choirs, the school and the people, sing *Kum, heiliger Geist* (Come, Holy Ghost) or *Nun bitten wir* (Now pray we) in alternation. Then he turns to the people and says the open confession and the absolution for them. **Nördlingen, *Kirchenordnung* of Kaspar Löner, 1544** (Sehling 12, pp. 311–312):

On high feasts the pastor himself shall hold the high office, but on the others and on Sundays the old pastor shall come before the altar in his due vesture, and there receive the absolution from one of his fellow ministers upon his Confiteor. Meanwhile two choirs, the one of the school, the other of the people, shall on high feasts sing *Kum, hailiger Geist* (Come, Holy Ghost) in turn, all three stanzas out; but on other feasts and Sundays *Nun bitten wir den Heiligen Gaist* (Now pray we the Holy Ghost) with all its stanzas. When that is out, the celebrant shall turn to the people, or, if they would needs remain in the choir, come out before the altar, and there say before the people the Confiteor or open confession, and thereupon the absolution.

Editor's notes (pp. 311–312). On the celebrant's *Confiteor* (p. 311):

What is meant here, then, is a preparation appointed only for the clergyman and his ministrant, as in Brandenburg 1540 and Pfalz-Neuburg 1542, or, restricted to the clergyman, in Brandenburg-Nürnberg 1533 and in V. Dietrich's *Agendbüchlein* 1543. Whether it refers only to the Confiteor and the Misereatur together with the Indulgentiam in the narrowest sense, or whether the whole prayers at the foot of the altar of the Mass are meant (which, moreover, are not contained in the missals before 1570, but must have been known from elsewhere), cannot be decided.

On the open confession to the people (p. 312):

The Open Confession is here a general preparatory service of worship for the congregation, as also with Volprecht and Döber; not a substitute for confession, or its repetition, as with Kantz or in Nürnberg.

What family A shows.

- **No text.** The orders do not print the *Confiteor* they mean. Brandenburg-Nürnberg leaves the choice to the priest's "devotion"; Hohenlohe alone demands the "pure" Latin *Confiteor* of the Missal.
- **Who.** The priest alone (Brandenburg-Nürnberg, Hohenlohe, Amberg, Buxtehude, Schleswig-Holstein), with his ministrants (Brandenburg 1540, Pfalz-Neuburg), with the second ministrant in dialogue (Regensburg), or with a fellow minister who absolves him (Nördlingen).
- **When.** At the altar, kneeling, during the Introit or the opening hymn. It is never said in the sacristy, and never before the bells.
- **The people** do not hear it. It is the evangelical remnant of the *Stufengebet* (prayers at the foot of the altar).

3.3.3 Family B: Bugenhagen's kneeling prayer with the sexton

Bugenhagen's later orders replace the *Confiteor* (I confess) with the Our Father and the tract *Domine, non secundum peccata nostra* (O Lord, deal not with us after our sins; Ps 103:10; Ps 79:8–9). The priest kneels with the sexton and prays "for himself and for the people and for all the need of Christendom". The sexton answers each versicle. This is the form in Braunschweig-

Wolfenbüttel 1543 (Sehling 6/1, pp. 54–55) and Hildesheim 1544 (Sehling 7/2.1, p. 852). Both texts, with translations and the full versicles, are in Chapter 7 §§7.15.1–7.15.2.

Note.

- The prayer is said aloud but at the altar, during the opening German psalm, so that in practice the people would not have followed it.
- The versicle *Domine, ne memineris iniquitatum nostrarum antiquarum* (O Lord, remember not our former iniquities; Ps 79:8) is the nearest thing in the corpus to the antiphon *Ne reminiscaris* (Remember not) of the Missal's preparation (Tobit 3:3), which does not occur (§3.6.2).

3.3.4 Family C: Döber and the Mecklenburg public confession

The form. This is the most important family, because it is the source of the modern Lutheran confession of sins (§3.4.5). It keeps the shape of the Roman *Stufengebet* (prayers at the foot of the altar) but speaks it aloud, in German, in the people's hearing:

1. an address to the people: "My dearly beloved in God, open your hearts …";
2. the priest kneels; *Adiutorium nostrum* (Our help) and *Confitemini Domino*;
3. a new confession in the first person singular ("I, poor sinful man …"), said by the priest for all;
4. a prayer for forgiveness in the plural, in the place of the *Misereatur* (May [almighty God] have mercy);
5. a declaration of God's mercy, in the place of the *Indulgentiam* (Pardon), ending "God grant this unto us all".

It begins in Nürnberg with Andreas Döber's Mass for the New Hospital. **Nürnberg, Andreas Döber, *Von der evangelischen meß … im Newen Spital*, 1525** (Sehling 11, p. 51):

First, when the priest cometh to the altar and hath taken the chalice out of the bag, he turneth to the people and speaketh aloud, as hereafter followeth (and so also all the words that are in the whole Mass), so that he may yet be understood of the hearers: My dearly beloved in God, open your hearts, and let us confess our sins unto God, and say after me with hearty desire, in the name of the Father and of the Son and of the Holy Ghost! Amen. Therewith the priest kneeleth down before the altar and saith full slowly as hereafter followeth. Our help be in the name of the Lord, who hath made heaven and earth! Confess unto the Lord, for he is good, and his mercy is everlasting. And I, poor sinful man, confess unto God almighty, my Creator and Redeemer, that I have sinned not only in thoughts, words or works, but was also conceived and born in sins, so that all my nature and being is before his righteousness punishable and damnable. Therefore I flee unto his bottomless mercy, seek and pray for grace. Lord, be merciful to me a poor sinner! The merciful God vouchsafe to have mercy upon us, and forgive us our sins, and give us the Holy Ghost, that through him we may fulfil his divine will and receive everlasting life. Amen. The absolution. The priest saith: Incline your heart to God! The almighty, merciful God hath had mercy upon us, and hath given his only Son unto death for our sins, and for his sake forgiven us; and to all them also that believe on his holy name he hath given power to become the children of God, and hath promised the Holy Ghost. He that believeth and is baptized shall be saved. God grant this unto us all. Amen. And unto every one be it done according to his faith! As he saith: Pray God for me, the same will I also do for you! he standeth up before the altar and saith for the people (and the people also may pray with him) thus: Come, Holy Ghost, fill the hearts of thy faithful and kindle in them the fire of thy divine love, who through divers tongues hast gathered the peoples of the whole world in the unity of the faith! God be praised!

Note.

- **The Roman skeleton.** *Adiutorium* (Our help) and *Confitemini* (O give thanks) are the versicles of the German missals. "The merciful God vouchsafe to have mercy upon us …" is the *Misereatur*, now in the plural ("us") and said by the priest for priest and people together. "The almighty, merciful God hath had mercy upon us …" stands where the *Indulgentiam* stood, and its opening words echo it.
- **The *Orate fratres*.** "Pray God for me; the same will I also do" is the Roman request for the people's prayers, moved here from the offertory.
- **The absolution** is a declaration in the perfect tense ("hath had mercy") that ends in a wish ("God grant this unto us all"). It is neither the indicative "I absolve you" nor the optative *Misereatur*; see §3.4.4.
- **Sehling's editor** notes that the *Form und Ordnung einer christlichen meß* (Form and order of a Christian Mass) (Sehling 11, pp. 56 ff.) takes over this beginning, headed "The Confiteor".

The Low German Mass of Lippe follows Döber. The choir sings the Introit or *Veni Sancte Spiritus* (Come, Holy Spirit) while the priest reads the confession. **Lippe, *Deutsche Messe*, [c. 1525–1538]** (Sehling 22, p. 565):

First the priest readeth the Confiteor. The Confiteor. Our help be in the name of the Lord, who hath made heaven and earth. Confess unto the Lord, for he is good, and his mercy is everlasting. And I, poor sinful man, confess unto God almighty, my Creator and Redeemer, that I have sinned not only in thoughts, words or works, but was also conceived and born in sins, so that all my nature and being is before his mercy punishable and damnable; therefore I flee unto his bottomless mercy, seek and pray for grace. Lord, be merciful to me a poor sinner. The absolution. The almighty, merciful God, who for our sins hath given his only Son unto death, vouchsafe to have mercy upon us, and for his sake forgive us our sins, and grant the Holy Ghost unto all that believe on him, that through him we may fulfil his divine will and receive everlasting life, amen. […] But while the priest readeth the Confiteor, the choir singeth the Introit of the Mass.

Note. Here the optative prayer ("vouchsafe to have mercy") is itself headed "The absolution". Döber's declaration is missing.

The Kiel Mass takes Döber's address and confession, but its absolution is Kantz's indicative form, and it is read by the sexton. **Schleswig-Holstein, *Deutsche Messe* (Kiel), [after 1526]** (Sehling 23, p. 55):

The Confiteor. My dearly beloved in God, open your hearts and let us confess our sins unto God, and say after me with desirous heart: In the name of the Father and of the Son and of the Holy Ghost. Amen. I, poor sinful man, confess myself unto God almighty, my Creator and Redeemer, that I have sinned not only in thoughts, words or works, but was also conceived and born in sins, so that all my nature and being is before his righteousness punishable and damnable. Therefore have I refuge unto his bottomless mercy, seek and desire grace: Lord, be merciful to me a poor sinner. The merciful God vouchsafe to have mercy upon us, and forgive us our sins, and grant the Holy Ghost, that through him we may fulfil his divine will and receive everlasting life. Amen.

There follow the *Misereatur*, read by minister and sexton, and an absolution read by the sexton: "And I, by the commandment of our Lord Jesus Christ, say unto you … free, quit and loosed of all your sins" (Sehling 23, p. 55; full text in Chapter 7 §7.11.1). "I have refuge" is the reading that Mecklenburg and the later orders keep.

Mecklenburg 1540: the country Mass. The Low German *Ordeninge der misse* (Order of the Mass) puts the confession at the head of every communion Mass. The sexton, "or another Christian", kneels with the priest and says the prayer for forgiveness. **Mecklenburg, *Ordeninge der misse*, 1540/1545** (Sehling 5, pp. 150–151):

A common Mass for them that will be communicated shall be held on Sundays and other feast days in the accustomed Mass vestment, upon an altar that shall be prepared and covered for the purpose. The priest, when he hath vested himself, let him turn about before the altar and say to the people: My dearly beloved in God, open your hearts, let us confess our sins unto God, and say after me with hearty desire. In the name of the Father, of the Son and of the Holy Ghost, amen. Then let him fall upon his knees before the altar, and the sexton or another Christian by him; then let the parson say aloud: Our help be in the name of the Lord. Answer: Who hath made heaven and earth. The priest: Confess unto the Lord, for he is good. Answer: And his mercy is everlasting. The priest: And I, poor sinful man, confess unto God almighty, my Creator and Redeemer, that I have sinned not only in thoughts, words or works, but was also conceived and born in sins, so that all my nature and being is before his righteousness punishable and damnable. Therefore I flee unto his bottomless mercy, seek and desire grace; Lord, be merciful to me a poor sinner. The minister answereth this prayer: The almighty, merciful God, who for our sins hath given his only Son unto death, vouchsafe to have mercy upon us, and for his sake forgive us our sins, and grant the Holy Ghost, that through him we may fulfil his divine will and receive everlasting life, amen. The priest saith hereafter this absolution: The merciful God hath had mercy upon us, and hath given his only Son unto death for us, and for his sake forgiven us our sins; and to all them also that believe on his holy name he hath given power to become the children of God, and hath promised the Holy Ghost. Whoso believeth and is baptized, he shall be saved. God grant this unto us all, amen. When this confession is spoken by the priest, the whole church shall be still and hear this confession, and also confess their sins with the priest in like manner, and learn the prayer with the absolution, [to say it] at that time, and also otherwise right often before God. Hereafter in the towns the cantor or schoolmaster shall begin the Introit in Latin, or sing at times a German psalm.

The church order of 1552 puts the same form into High German and makes it the beginning of every Mass. The wording of the confession changes here into the form the later orders keep. **Mecklenburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1552** (Sehling 5, pp. 197–198):

Mass or communion. The same shall be begun, as heretofore ordained and in use in this land, with the common or public confession, prayer and absolution, by the priest; namely thus. The priest shall turn about before the altar toward the people, and

say: My dearly beloved in God, open your hearts, let us confess our sins unto God, and pray for forgiveness in the name of our Lord Jesus Christ. Say after me with hearty desire unto God, in faith in the Lord Jesus Christ, through the Holy Ghost. Then the priest kneeleth down before the altar, and another minister of the church or the custos beside him, and the priest saith with a loud voice: Our help standeth in the name of the Lord. The choir answereth: Who hath made heaven and earth. The priest: I, poor sinful man, confess before thee, O almighty God, my Creator and Redeemer, that I have sinned not only in thoughts, words and works, but that I am also by nature sinful and unclean, conceived and born in sins. But I have refuge unto thy bottomless mercy, seek and desire grace, for the Lord Jesus Christ's sake. Lord, be merciful to me a poor sinner. The other minister answereth this prayer: O almighty, merciful God, who hast given thine only-begotten Son unto death for us, vouchsafe to have mercy upon us, and for the sake of the same thy beloved Son forgive us all our sins; and also give us thy Holy Ghost, who may kindle and increase in us true knowledge of thy divine being and will, and thereto true obedience toward thee; to the end that we may obtain everlasting life through thy grace, for the Lord Jesus Christ's sake, amen. The priest saith hereafter this absolution: The almighty, merciful God hath had mercy upon us, forgiveth us truly all our sins for the sake of his dear Son, whom for our sakes he hath given unto death, and hath given power to become the children of God to all that believe on his name, giveth us moreover his Holy Ghost; he that believeth and is baptized shall be saved. God grant this unto us all, amen. While this confession, prayer and absolution is spoken, the whole church shall be still and hear it, and also with the priest likewise confess, pray, and take the absolution to heart, learn it well, and often say the like before God. After this the choir singeth the Introit *de dominica* (of the Sunday) or *de festo* (of the feast).

Note.

- **"as ordered heretofore in this land"** points back to 1540.
- **What changes from 1540.**
  - The *Confitemini* versicle is dropped. The choir, not the sexton, answers *Adiutorium*.
  - The confession turns from the third person ("confess unto God") to the second ("confess before thee, O almighty God").
  - It adds "by nature sinful and unclean" and "But I have refuge unto thy bottomless mercy".
  - The second minister's prayer becomes a collect with a relative clause ("thou who …") and asks for "true knowledge … and true obedience".
  - The absolution gains "forgiveth us truly all our sins", in the present tense.
- **The people.** In 1540 and 1552 the people are told to keep silence, confess with the priest in their hearts, and learn the text. They do not say it aloud, despite the "Say after me" (say after me) of the address. The address keeps the phrase from Döber.
- **Pfalz-Zweibrücken** copies 1552 word for word (below).

Pfalz-Zweibrücken 1557 and Pfalz-Veldenz 1574: the Mecklenburg form in the Palatinate. The Zweibrücken order prints the 1552 form whole, after an opening hymn to the Holy Ghost sung "until the church gathers". **Pfalz-Zweibrücken, *Kirchenordnung*, 1557** (Sehling 18, p. 187):

When, then, the Supper of Christ is purposed to be held in the church on a Sunday or other holy day, there shall first be sung the hymn *Komm heyliger Geyst* (Come, Holy Ghost), etc., *Nun bitten wir den heyligen Geyst* (Now pray we the Holy Ghost), etc., or else a German psalm or spiritual song, especially one agreeable to the season, until the church cometh together. […] Then the priest kneeleth down before the altar, and another minister of the church or the custos beside him, and the priest saith with a loud voice: Our help standeth in the name of the Lord. The choir answereth: Who hath made heaven and earth.

Editor's notes (p. 187). The section from here to the Words of Institution is "from the Mecklenburg church order of 1552". The Zweibrücken hymnal of 1571/1587 reprints it under the heading "Confession, prayer and absolution before the sermon on Sunday", that is, as the opening of every Sunday service, communion or not.

Pfalz-Veldenz takes over the Zweibrücken text with one change that matters: the second minister has gone, and the minister says the confession, the prayer for forgiveness and the absolution himself, kneeling for the first two and standing for the third. **Pfalz-Veldenz, *Kirchenordnung*, 1574** (Sehling 18, pp. 498–499):

When they are assembled together to hold the Supper, the table of the Lord, which is otherwise called the altar, shall first be covered with a clean white cloth and be made ready with bread and wine; then they begin to sing, kneeling: *Nun bitten wir den heiligen Geist* (Now pray we the Holy Ghost), or *Khom, heiliger Geist* (Come, Holy Ghost), etc. Thereupon the pastor exhorteth to the confession of sins and to hearty prayer for the forgiveness of the same, about with such words: My dearly beloved in the

Lord, let us confess our sins unto God and pray for forgiveness in the name of our Lord Jesus Christ; open therefore your hearts and say after me with hearty desire unto God, in faith in the Lord Christ, through the Holy Ghost. […] Then the minister kneeleth down and saith before the people with a loud voice: I, poor sinful man, confess before thee, O almighty God, my Creator and Redeemer, that I have, alas, sinned much, not only in thoughts, words and works, but that I am by nature sinful and unclean, conceived and born in sins. But I have refuge unto thy bottomless mercy, seek and desire grace for the Lord Jesus Christ's sake; Lord, be merciful to me a poor sinner. Almighty, merciful God, who hast given thine only-begotten Son unto death for us, vouchsafe to have mercy upon us, and for the sake of the same, thy beloved Son, forgive us all our sins; also give thy Holy Ghost, who may kindle and increase in us true knowledge of thy divine being and will, and thereto true obedience toward thee, to the end that we may pass this our life according to all thy good pleasure, and hereafter obtain everlasting life through thy grace, for the Lord Jesus Christ's sake, etc. The absolution is spoken by the minister when he hath stood up: The almighty, merciful God hath had mercy upon us, forgiveth us truly all our sins and misdeeds for the sake of his beloved Son, whom for our sakes he hath given unto death, and hath given power to become the children of God to all that believe on his name, giveth us moreover his Holy Ghost, who enlighteneth us and leadeth us into all truth, that we may be saved; God grant this unto us all, through Jesus Christ, our Saviour. Amen.

Amberg 1555: the confession in the plural. The Amberg order of 1555 takes the Mecklenburg form for its Mass on feast days. Sehling's editor notes that the section is taken "wholly from Mecklenburg 1552". But it changes the priest's confession from the singular to the plural, so that it is no longer "I, poor sinful man" but "We poor sinful men". **Amberg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1555** (Sehling 13, p. 290):

First shall the choir sing the *Veni, Sancte*, and afterward the priest, in the accustomed vestment, *Adjutorium nostrum in nomine* (Our help is in the name) [Ps 124:8]. Thereupon the choir respondeth *Qui fecit celum et terram* (Who made heaven and earth) [Ps 124:8]. Then shall he turn before the altar toward the people and say with a loud voice: My dearly beloved in God! Open your hearts, let us confess our sins before God and pray for forgiveness in the name of our Lord Jesus Christ! Say after me with hearty desire unto God, in faith in the Lord Jesus Christ, through the Holy Ghost! Then let the priest kneel down before the altar, and another minister of the church beside him, and say with a loud voice: We poor, sinful men confess before thee, O almighty God, our Creator and Redeemer, that we have sinned not only with thoughts, words and works, but that we are also by nature sinful and damned, conceived and born in sins. But we have refuge unto thy bottomless mercy, and seek and desire grace for the Lord Jesus Christ's sake. Lord, be merciful to us poor sinners! The other minister of the church answereth this prayer: O almighty, merciful God, who hast given thine only-begotten Son unto death for us! Vouchsafe to have mercy upon us, and for the sake of the same, thy beloved Son, forgive us all our sins, and give us also thy Holy Ghost, who may kindle, increase and preserve in us true knowledge of thy divine being and will, and thereto true obedience toward thee, that we may obtain eternal life through thy grace, for the Lord Jesus Christ's sake! Amen. Let the priest then stand up and thereafter speak this absolution toward the people, and the other minister of the church shall remain kneeling the while: The almighty, merciful God hath had mercy upon us, forgiveth us truly all our sins for his dear Son's sake, whom for our sakes he hath given unto death, and hath given power to become the children of God to all that believe on his name, and giveth us moreover his Holy Ghost. He that believeth and is baptized shall be saved. God grant this unto us all! Amen. And while this confession, prayer and absolution are spoken, the whole church shall be still and hear it, and also with the priest so confess, pray and take the absolution to heart, learn it well, and often say the like before God.

Note. The plural confession and the instruction that the church shall "with the priest so confess" bring Amberg nearer than any other sixteenth-century witness to the Common Service, whose confession begins "Almighty God, our Maker and Redeemer, we poor sinners confess unto Thee" (§3.4.5). Sehling's apparatus shows that the text it calls the *Bericht* (report) reads "unrein" (unclean), as Mecklenburg does, where the order of 1555 has "verdamt" (damned).

Hadeln: the confession sung, the sexton absolving. The Hadeln order, which Sehling dates 1526, has the priest vest during the *Te Deum* (We praise thee, O God) at the end of Matins and kneel for *Veni Sancte Spiritus*. He then sings the confession on the same tone, and the sexton answers and reads the absolution. **Hadeln, *Kirchenordnung* "of 1526"** (Sehling 5, pp. 467–468):

While the Te Deum is being sung, the priest shall clothe himself with the accustomed Mass vestment, not as needful, but as a seemly and honest ornament, and not seek salvation therein. Likewise one or two wax lights shall be lit (since it is the Lord's Supper) and be let burn upon the altar until the Mass is out. When then the collect of Matins hath been sung, the priest shall go humbly to kneel upon his knees and sing with the choir *Veni sancte spiritus* in Latin or German. The collect being ended, the priest remaineth kneeling and beginneth aloud the confession on the same tone, and the sexton by him answereth and readeth the absolution. Then a psalm is sung before the Introit, of the Sunday or of the Trinity or of the Holy Ghost or of Easter, or whatever is not contrary to Scripture.

Note. One manuscript (Sehling's VIII, 65) adds the remark: "Nota bene: the Confiteor with the sexton's absolution has fallen [away]" (Sehling 5, p. 468). The sexton's absolution was given up at some later date.

3.3.5 Family D: the *Offene Schuld* moved into the Mass

The *Offene Schuld*. The late medieval *Offene Schuld* ("open guilt") was a general confession, with a declaratory absolution, recited by the preacher after the sermon in the vernacular preaching service. It was never part of the Mass. The first evangelical Masses carry it into the Mass, as an absolution of the communicants. Sehling's editor sets out the development under Volprecht 1524 (Sehling 11, p. 39):

As already the German Mass of Kaspar Kantz in Nördlingen 1522, the Strasbourg German Mass 1524, and Döber's Mass, after the medieval model, first in the preaching service, but then also after the sermon in the Mass. In this passage out of the preaching service into the Mass, however, the Open Confession was changed, as this use of it shows, in the feeling of the people from an appendage of the sermon into a preparation for the Sacrament.

Kantz, Nördlingen 1522. The earliest form opens with an exhortation, then gives the absolution with no confession text at all: "The almighty and merciful God forgive you your sins! And I, by the commandment of our Lord Jesus Christ, in the stead of the holy Church, pronounce you free, quit and loosed of all your sins …" (Sehling 12, p. 285). Sehling's editor calls it a fusion of the *Indulgentiam* (Pardon) with the absolution of private confession. The full text, with *Adiutorium* (Our help) and the recast *Orate fratres*, is in Chapter 7 §7.2.1.

Bremen 1525. The Low German *Evangelische Misse* (Evangelical Mass) printed at Bremen in 1525 translates Kantz's address and absolution: "The almighty, merciful God forgive you your sins. And I, by the commandment of our Lord Jesus Christ, in the stead of the holy Church, proclaim you to be free, quit and loosed of all your sins" (Sehling 7/2.2, p. 405). It heads the priest's request for the people's prayer "the priest's confession", and keeps Kantz's *Adiutorium* and *Veni Sancte Spiritus* (Come, Holy Spirit). The address is printed in §3.5.14.1.

Volprecht, Nürnberg 1524. The prior of the Augustinians at Nürnberg says an *offene beicht* (open confession) "in place of the Confiteor" before the Introit, addressed to God and to "brothers and sisters". The absolution that follows is headed "Absolution, the Misereatur". **Nürnberg, *Deutsche Messe* of the prior Volprecht, 1524** (Sehling 11, pp. 39–40):

When the priest will read a German Mass, he saith beforehand the open confession instead of the Confiteor: I, poor, wretched, sinful man, confess myself unto God my heavenly Father and unto my Lord Jesus Christ my Saviour, unto you, brothers and sisters, and unto the whole Christian congregation, that I have, alas, often and much sinned against God my Lord with unbelief and mistrust, not loved him above all things, and my neighbour as myself. That is sore and grievous unto me from the bottom of my heart. O Lord God, almighty Father, I, a poor sinner, put thee in mind of thy gracious pledge and promise, wherein thou promisest forgiveness of sins through the blood of thy Son Jesus Christ, who died for us and shed his blood for us for the forgiveness of sins. The same my Lord Jesus Christ hath also spoken by his holy mouth: where two or three are gathered together in his name, there is he in the midst of them; and what they ask of thee in his name, that shall be granted them. So we pray for the pardon of our sins in his name. Lord God, say unto us: According to thy faith be it unto thee! Go in peace! Sin no more! Thy sins are forgiven, pardoned and remitted thee. Absolution, the Misereatur: My dear brother and sister, God hath had mercy upon us, and hath pardoned us all our sins, and will give us everlasting life. Amen.

Note.

- **"you brothers and sisters"** keeps the *Confiteor*'s "and to you, brethren", with the saints left out.
- **The absolution** is in the first person plural ("us"), so the priest includes himself; it is a declaration, not a sentence of loosing.

Naumburg 1537: an indicative absolution at the start of Mass. At St. Wenzel's in Naumburg the choir sings *Kom heiliger geist herre gott* (Come, Holy Ghost, Lord God), and the priest then reads "the Confiteor to the people". It is a bidding to prayer, a confession said by all, and an absolution in the first person singular. **Naumburg, *Kirchen-Ordnung* for St. Wenzel's, 1537** (Sehling 2, pp. 77–78):

Thereupon the priest readeth the Confiteor to the people, as followeth. Dear friends, forasmuch as we are now all gathered in the service of God the almighty to hear his holy, godly word, we will first call upon the Lord for his grace and pray him that he would open our hearts to the true understanding of his divine word […] But forasmuch as we are all sinners, let us first confess

our sins and beg pardon for the same of God the almighty, and say: I, poor sinner, confess unto thee, O almighty God and merciful Father, before this whole congregation all my sins and misdeeds, whereby I have so manifoldly provoked thee to wrath; and I pray thee, through thy bottomless mercy and through the bitter passion and death of thy dear Son JESUS CHRIST, that thou wouldest be gracious to me, poor sinner. Absolution. Upon this your confession, by the command of the Lord Jesus Christ, in the stead of the holy Christian Church, I forgive you all your sins, in the name of the Father and of the Son and of the Holy Ghost. Amen. The peace of the Lord Jesus Christ be with you all. Amen. Thereupon the whole choir singeth the Kyrie eleison.

Note. "Upon such your confession … in the stead of the holy Christian church I forgive you all your sins" is the formula of private confession, used here over the whole congregation. Compare the Brandenburg and Pfalz-Neuburg prohibitions of a "gemeine beicht" (common confession; §3.4.6).

3.3.6 Family E: the Upper German and Reformed opening

In Strasbourg (Moderate Reformed, before the Interim) and the Reformed orders the service begins with the minister's call to confession, a prayer of confession in the first person plural, and a comfortable word as absolution. This is the *Offene Schuld* (open confession) of the preaching service, kept at its head. **Strasbourg, *Agende*, 1537/1541** (Moderate Reformed; Sehling 20/1, p. 270):

The Confiteor or open confession: Confess unto God the Lord, and acknowledge with me, every one, his sins and misdeeds: Almighty, everlasting God and Father, we confess and acknowledge unto thee that we were conceived in iniquities, and are full of sin and transgression in all our life, as they that neither believe thy word perfectly nor follow thy holy commandments. We pray thee, look upon thy goodness, and for thy name's sake be gracious and pardon our misdeed, which, alas, is great. An absolution or comfortable word, 1 Timothy 1: This is a true saying and a precious word: Christ Jesus came into the world to save sinners. Let every one confess himself in truth with Saint Paul in his heart, and believe in Christ; so I promise you in his name the pardon of all your sins, and pronounce you loosed of the same on earth, that ye may be loosed of them also in heaven for ever, Amen. Sometimes he taketh other sayings that comfort us with the pardon of sins and Christ's payment for our sins, as John 3: God so loved the world, that he gave his only Son, that whosoever believeth in him should not perish, but have everlasting life.

Note.

- **The name.** "The Confiteor or open confession": in Strasbourg (1537, Moderate Reformed) the open confession *is* the *Confiteor* (I confess).
- **The absolution** is conditional on each one's confession and faith ("Let each one confess … and believe … so I promise you"). Further comfortable words follow: John 3:35–36, Acts 10:43 and 1 John 2:1–2 (p. 271).
- **A second Confiteor** follows: "Almighty, everlasting God and Father, we confess and acknowledge that we were, alas, conceived and born in sins, and therefore inclined to all evil and slothful to all good …; p. 271". The Palatinate editor names this "other Confiteor" among the sources of the Palatinate prayer below.

The Palatinate 1563 (Reformed). The Reformed order of Elector Frederick III opens the Sunday morning service with a prayer of confession before the sermon, and puts the confession, absolution and retention after the sermon (§3.4.4). The prayer before the sermon begins **Palatinate, *Kirchenordnung*, 1563** (Reformed; Sehling 14, p. 388):

Before the sermon, especially on Sundays and holy days in the morning, and on days of prayer, this following prayer shall be spoken before the people, wherein the Christian congregation is expressly reminded of man's misery, and the wholesome grace of God is desired, to the end that hearts may be made ready unto humility and receive the word of grace the more desirously. Grace, peace and mercy, etc. Heavenly Father, eternal and merciful God, we confess and acknowledge before thy divine majesty that we are poor, wretched sinners, conceived and born in all wickedness and corruption, inclined to all evil, unprofitable to any good, and that with our sinful life we transgress thy holy commandments without ceasing

Note.

- **The opening** is the apostolic greeting "Grace, peace and mercy" in the place of the versicles. The prayer ends with the Our Father (p. 389).
- **The editor** traces the prayer to Geneva 1563 and Frankfurt 1555 (both Reformed) and "Strasbourg … (the other Confiteor)", the second Strasbourg confession above (Moderate Reformed).
- **Poullain and Micron** (both Reformed). The French stranger church at Frankfurt opens with *Adiutorium nostrum in nomine Domini* (Our help is in the name of the Lord) and a *Confessio peccatorum* (confession of sins), "O Lord God, eternal Father

…" (Sehling 9, p. 563). Micron's Dutch order for London, also used at Emden, has an open confession with a conditional declaration (Sehling 7/1, p. 602).

Wertheim 1524: the confession after the sermon. The earliest report of a Mass after the sermon is Franz Kolb's letter to Luther. **Wertheim, Franz Kolb to Luther, 27 August 1524** (Sehling 11, p. 707):

First we all come together to the sermon; the sermon being done, straightway, the ornaments hitherto used being laid aside, bread and wine being made ready, with knees bowed before the altar, I say with a loud voice and in German a very short Confiteor, then the Pater noster, thirdly the Credo in Deum; straightway I rise, consecrate the bread with the bare words of Christ, and the cup, and without any exhortation communicate my brother the chaplain with the other brethren and sisters.

3.3.7 Family F: a hymn, a psalm or *Veni Sancte Spiritus* at the beginning

Luther. The *Formula missae* (1523) begins with the Introit. The *Deutsche Messe* (1526) begins with a German hymn or psalm, followed directly by the Kyrie. **Wittenberg, Luther, *Deudsche messe und ordnung gottis diensts*, 1526** (Sehling 1, p. 14):

But at the beginning we sing a spiritual song or a German psalm in the first tone, after the manner as followeth: "I will bless the Lord at all times" (Psalm 34:1–23). Thereupon Kyrie eleison, also in the same tone, three times and not nine times.

Luther's Mass has no confession and no versicles before the Introit or the opening psalm.

The Holy Ghost before the Introit. Several orders recast the medieval *accessus* as a congregational preparation of the Holy Ghost. At the Amberg hospital church the schoolmaster and boys sing *Veni Sancte* (Come, Holy [Spirit]), and the priest sings a German collect with the versicle. **Amberg, *Ordnung der kirchen … im spital*, 1544** (Sehling 13, p. 282):

First, when the priest in his habit, according to the old use of the church, goeth up to the altar, our schoolmaster singeth with the boys the Latin *Veni, Sancte* …; thereupon the priest a German collect together with the versicle, praying for the grace of the Holy Ghost. Afterward the choir singeth the Introit of the Mass of the Holy Trinity, or else *de tempore* (of the season).

Editor's note (p. 282). This is "a preparation for the congregation in place of the prayers at the foot of the altar, with the Confiteor", probably a form of the *accessus*. The note is quoted in full in §3.6.1. The collect is presumably the Pentecost collect *Deus, qui corda fidelium* (O God, who didst teach the hearts of the faithful), and the versicle *Cor mundum crea in me, Deus* (Create in me a clean heart, O God), which Luther used at his ordinations (WA 38, 424).

At Verden the choir sings *Veni Sancte Spiritus*, the priest sings *Emitte Spiritum tuum* (Send forth thy Spirit), and the collect *Deus, qui corda fidelium* follows. **Verden, *Kirchenordnung*, 1606** (Sehling 7/1, pp. 155–156):

First, when the priest or pastor hath stepped before the altar, the choir shall begin the antiphon *Veni, sancte Spiritus*. Thereafter the priest shall sing: *Emitte Spiritum et creabuntur* (Send forth thy Spirit, and they shall be created). The choir shall answer: *Et renovabis faciem terrae* (And thou shalt renew the face of the earth) […] Further the priest shall sing: *Oremus. Deus, qui corda fidelium* (Let us pray. O God, who didst teach the hearts of the faithful). Thereupon shall be sung the Introit *de tempore*, Kyrie eleison, Gloria in excelsis Deo, and Et in terra pax.

Editor's note (p. 155): "Our liturgy up to the Introit is a *praeparatio ad missam*. In the later Middle Ages the private preparatory office of the priest, the *accessus*, had sometimes been made into an hour of the clergy, as it were an 'office of the Holy Ghost".

The same pattern stands in other orders:

- **Kantz 1522** and **Döber 1525**: *Veni Sancte Spiritus*, said by the priest for the people after the absolution (§3.3.4).
- **Buxtehude 1552**: on weekdays a German psalm before the Introit, "such as Come, Holy Ghost" (Sehling 7/1, p. 74).
- **Naumburg 1537**, **Nördlingen 1544**, **Pfalz-Zweibrücken 1557** and **Pfalz-Veldenz 1574**: *Kom heiliger geist herre gott* (Come, Holy Ghost, Lord God) or *Nun bitten wir den heiligen Geist* (Now pray we the Holy Ghost), sung by the choir or congregation, at Pfalz-Veldenz kneeling.
- **Hadeln**: *Veni sancte spiritus*, priest kneeling with the choir (§3.3.4).
- **Hof 1592**: *Veni Sancte Spiritus* "before the Introit" at the Monday office in the monastery church, sung in three parts (Sehling 11, p. 464).

The Benedictus at Hermannstadt. The Transylvanian order sings Zechariah's canticle in German before the Introit on Sundays, in place of the abolished procession. **Transylvania, *Kirchenordnung*, 1547, Latin version** (Sehling 24, p. 223):

On Sundays, in place of the abolished procession, before the Introit, there is sung in German the canticle of Zacharias, *Benedictus Dominus* (Blessed be the Lord); or, if the litany please any better at that time; in Eastertide, *Salve festa dies* (Hail, festal day). On other feast days we leave these out, taking the beginning of the Mass from the Introit *de tempore* or another like it, if it be not contrary to Scripture.

In the villages. Where there was no Latin choir, a German psalm or hymn stood in place of the Introit:

- Mecklenburg 1540: "in the villages a German psalm shall always be sung before the Introit" (Sehling 5, p. 151).
- Brandenburg-Nürnberg 1533: "a Christian German song" (§3.3.2).
- Sayn 1590: "First, when one cometh into the church, a German psalm shall be sung; thereafter the pastor shall read a collect" (Sehling 19/1, p. 412).

3.3.8 Family G: Müntzer's Allstedt Mass; *Iudica me* and *Aufer a nobis* elsewhere

Müntzer keeps the *Stufengebet*. Thomas Müntzer's German Masses (Radical Reformation) for Allstedt are the one place in Sehling where Ps 43 *Iudica me* (Judge me) survives as the preparation for Mass. In the order of 1523 the Mass begins "when the general confession has first been made before the altar" (Sehling 1, p. 504). The *Deutsch evangelisch Messe* (German Evangelical Mass) of 1524 prints it. Ps 43 (the Vulgate's 42nd) is said by the priest and the whole people; it includes, as its fourth verse, the *Introibo ad altare Dei* (I will go in unto the altar of God) that the Roman Mass uses as its antiphon. Then come the priest's confession, the people's *Misereatur* (May [almighty God] have mercy), the versicle *Deus, tu conversus* (O God, thou wilt turn again), and the prayer *Aufer a nobis* (Take away from us), all in German, all aloud, and all before the Introit. **Allstedt, Thomas Müntzer, *Deutsch evangelisch Messe*, 1524** (Radical Reformation; Sehling 1, p. 499):

The Office of the Incarnation of Christ our Saviour. The 42nd psalm is said with the whole people, before the general confession is made. 1. O God, judge me and sever me from the ungodly kind, and deliver me from the deceitful knave. 2. For thou art the God of my strength. Why hast thou forsaken me? I went as one that mourneth, when the ungodly man oppressed me. 3. Send out thy light and truth, that they may lead me to the holy hill and to thy dwelling. 4. There will I come to the altar of God, to God, who maketh glad my youth. O God, my God, there will I confess thy praise upon the harp. 5. O my soul, why art thou cast down? Why makest thou me sad? Wait for the Lord; for I confess him. He is the health of my countenance, and he is my God. 6. Glory be to the Father and to the Son and to the Holy Ghost. As it was in the beginning, is now and ever, and from eternity to eternity. Then the common people answer: Amen. The priest maketh the confession with clear words before all the people, saying: O mild God, Father, I confess to thee and to thy tender Son, Jesus Christ, and to the Comforter, the Holy Ghost, before all them that fear God, that I, a wretched sinner, have all my life long done against thy will (which is declared by the law), and with negligent confidence, unexercised faith and unstudious love have given place to sins, and have not turned them away in desire, words and works through God's work and word. Therefore I pray you, the chosen friends of God that stand about, to help to pray for me with all your heart, mind and strength, that the secret of the divine covenant may be opened through my speech and through your hearing. The common people saith thereupon: God be gracious unto thee, and teach thee from day to day to heed all his will and work for our good, in doing and in leaving undone. The priest saith thereupon: Amen. And straightway he saith this verse: O God, turn thee unto us as a faithful instructor. The people answer thereupon: That we, thy people, may be joyful in thee. Thereafter the priest saith: O Lord, not unto us, not unto us. Answer: But give the glory unto thy name. The priest saith: Let us pray: O Lord, take from us our iniquity, that with an upright mind we may wait upon thy holy, divine power in the witness of the words to come, through Jesus Christ, our Lord. Amen.

What Müntzer keeps, and what he changes.

Roman *Stufengebet* (prayers at the foot of the altar)	**Müntzer 1524**
Introibo ad altare Dei (I will go in unto the altar of God; antiphon)	Not said as an antiphon; kept only as verse 4 of the psalm, "Then will I come unto the altar of God"
Ps 43 *Iudica me*, priest and server in alternation, with *Gloria Patri*	Ps 43 in German, "with the whole people", with *Gloria Patri*; the people answer *Amen*
Adiutorium nostrum (Our help)	Not present

Roman *Stufengebet* (prayers at the foot of the altar)	**Müntzer 1524**
Confiteor (I confess) of the priest, asking the bystanders to pray for him	A new confession by the priest "before all the people", asking "you chosen friends of God that stand about" to pray for him
Misereatur of the server	"God be gracious unto thee, teach thee from day to day …", said by the people
Confiteor of the server and the priest's *Misereatur* and *Indulgentiam* (Pardon)	Not present; there is no absolution
Deus, tu conversus vivificabis nos (O God, thou wilt turn again and quicken us) / *Et plebs tua laetabitur in te* (And thy people shall rejoice in thee)	"O God, turn thee unto us as a faithful instructor" / "That we, thy people, may be joyful in thee"
(not in the Roman form)	"O Lord, not unto us, not unto us" / "But unto thy name give the glory" (Ps 115:1)
Aufer a nobis	"O Lord, take from us our misdeeds …", recast to look forward to the "words to come"

The Roman versicles *Ostende nobis* (Show us) and *Domine, exaudi* (O Lord, hear), the *Dominus vobiscum* (The Lord be with you) and *Oramus te* (We pray thee) are gone. The server's part has passed to the whole congregation.

Elsewhere, *Aufer a nobis* alone. Outside Allstedt the prayer *Aufer a nobis* appears in one order for certain, and in another by the editor's conjecture:

- **The *Cellische Ordnungen* of 1545** sing it in Latin after the sermon, as the first of three verses during which the people kneel and pray "in place of the offertory". Its petition to enter "into the holy of holies" here leads into the Preface. **Albertine Saxony, *Die Cellischen Ordnungen*, 1545** (Sehling 1, p. 300):

After the sermon. One shall first sing the *Dominus vobiscum*, and thereafter begin these three verses. 1. Take away from us, O Lord, all our iniquities, that we may be worthy to enter with pure minds into the holy of holies. Alleluia. 2. Have mercy, have mercy, have mercy upon thy people, whom thou hast redeemed, O Christ, with thy blood, that thou be not angry with us for ever. Alleluia. 3. Hear, hear, hear, O Lord, our prayers, O Jesus Christ; make intercession for us. Alleluia.

- **Regensburg 1542.** During the litany, before the Introit, "the priest, together with the gospeller, prayeth the *Confiteor"; after the litany the priest sings "a collect in the name of the whole church" (Sehling 13, pp. 391–392). Sehling's editor takes this collect to be "probably the prayer *Aufer a nobis* of the Mass, but no longer the *Oramus te* that follows it, which was impossible for evangelicals". He adds that of the south German orders only Regensburg kept a prayer at this place, apart from the early Amberg form (Sehling 13, p. 392); but at Amberg 1550 he judges the collect "hardly the prayer *Aufer a nobis* that still belongs to the *Confiteor*" (Sehling 13, p. 285).

The Mass form of the *Confiteor*. On Regensburg 1542 the editor also notes that Brandenburg-Nürnberg 1533, Dietrich's *Agendbüchlein* (agenda booklet) of 1543 and Pfalz-Neuburg 1543 knew "only a 'Confiteor, or what his devotion bids him', said by the clergyman alone", whereas Regensburg's priest says it with the deacon; and that "in a similar way as at Regensburg, however, the Mass *Confiteor* was also used in 1544 at Nördlingen" (Sehling 13, p. 391). For Nördlingen see §3.3.2.

The verdict. *Introibo* (I will go in) as an antiphon and Ps 43 as the priest's preparatory psalm disappear from every order in Sehling except Müntzer's (Radical Reformation). *Aufer a nobis* survives at the beginning of Mass only at Allstedt and, if the editor is right, at Regensburg 1542; in the *Cellische Ordnungen* (Celle orders) it moves to the offertory. Ps 43 itself remains in the Lutheran orders as the Introit of Judica Sunday (e.g. Nördlingen 1579, Sehling 12, p. 379).

3.4 Confession and absolution: what the orders did with the *Confiteor*

3.4.1 Where it falls

The confession of sins stands in four different places in the orders, and a few orders have it in two:

Place	Form	Orders
Before the Introit, privately	The priest's *Confiteor* (I confess) or other prayer at the altar, during the Introit	Brandenburg-Nürnberg 1533, Brandenburg 1540, Pfalz-Neuburg 1543, Hohenlohe 1553, Regensburg 1542 and 1553, Amberg 1550, Buxtehude 1552, Bergedorf 1544, Schleswig-Holstein 1542, Nördlingen 1544; Bugenhagen's kneeling prayer at Wolfenbüttel 1543 and Hildesheim 1544 (§§3.3.2–3.3.3)
Before the Introit, publicly	Address, confession and absolution in the people's hearing	Müntzer 1523/1524 (Radical Reformation; with Ps 43, no absolution; §3.3.8); Volprecht 1524, Döber 1525, Lippe, Kiel, Mecklenburg 1540 and 1552, Amberg 1555, Naumburg 1537, Nördlingen 1544, Pfalz-Zweibrücken 1557, Pfalz-Veldenz 1574, Hadeln; Strasbourg 1537 (Moderate Reformed); Palatinate 1563 (Reformed; prayer before the sermon) (§§3.3.4–3.3.6)
After the sermon	Open confession from the pulpit, or at the altar before the Sacrament	Bugenhagen, Brunswick 1528; Wertheim 1524 (§3.3.6); Kurpfalz 1556; Palatinate 1563 (Reformed); Amberg 1550 (§3.4.4)
In the communion rite	Confession and absolution after the exhortation, before the Verba	Kantz 1522 and Bremen 1525; Augsburg 1530 (Moderate Reformed; the absolution inside the second exhortation); Regensburg c. 1544 and 1567; Hohenlohe 1553 (from the pulpit); Württemberg 1536 and its followers, among them Kurpfalz 1556 and Hanau-Lichtenberg 1573; Nürnberg after 1569; Mecklenburg 1552 (the absolution inside the exhortation); Marienhafe 1593 (a prayer of confession without absolution) (§§3.4.4, 3.5)

Mecklenburg 1552 has it twice: the public confession at the beginning of every Mass (§3.3.4), and an absolution inside the exhortation before communion (§3.5.9). **Nördlingen 1544** has it twice at the beginning: the celebrant's own *Confiteor*, absolved by a fellow minister, and then the open confession to the people (§3.3.2).

The Palatinate moves it. Kurpfalz 1556 sets the order "the sermon, open confession and common prayer" (Sehling 14, p. 165). In 1563, now Reformed, the confession and absolution follow the Sunday morning sermon, and the Supper has its own examination by questions (§3.4.4).

3.4.2 Who says it, and does the chancel party pray it together?

- **The priest alone.** In family A the priest says the *Confiteor* (I confess) by himself at the altar, silently or "for himself" (Brandenburg-Nürnberg 1533, Hohenlohe 1553, Amberg 1550, Schleswig-Holstein 1542).
- **The priest and the ministrants.** Brandenburg 1540 and Pfalz-Neuburg 1543 have the priest go to the altar "together with his ministrants". At Regensburg 1553 the priest prays the *Confiteor* kneeling with "the one ministrant (who at that time is the second)", that is, in the Roman dialogue with the server.
- **The priest and the sexton.** In the north the sexton is the server:
  - Bugenhagen's prayer is said by the priest kneeling "with the sexton" (Wolfenbüttel) or "with the sexton" (Hildesheim), who answers each versicle.
  - In Mecklenburg 1540 the sexton "or another Christian" kneels with the priest and says the prayer for forgiveness.
  - At Kiel the sexton reads the *Misereatur* (May [almighty God] have mercy) and the absolution, and the priest says "Amen".
  - At Hadeln the sexton answers the priest's sung confession and reads the absolution. One manuscript notes that this "has been given up".
- **The priest and a second minister.** Mecklenburg 1552 and Pfalz-Zweibrücken 1557: "another minister of the church, or the custos" kneels beside the priest; "the other minister" says the prayer for forgiveness; the choir answers *Adiutorium* (Our help). At Nördlingen 1544 a fellow minister absolves the celebrant.
- **The people.** The people take one of four parts:
  - They say it **after the priest**: "say after me" (Döber 1525) and "say the confession with me" (Bugenhagen 1528).
  - They **confess silently** with him: Mecklenburg 1540 and 1552, "the whole church shall be still … and also confess likewise with the priest".
  - They **confess in their hearts**: Strasbourg 1537 (Moderate Reformed), "let every one confess himself … in his heart".

- They **answer "Yes"** to questions: Palatinate 1563 (Reformed; §3.4.4).

Is it done privately before Mass? In two senses, yes:

- **The priest.** His *Confiteor* (family A) is private, but it is said at the altar at the beginning of Mass, not in the sacristy beforehand.
- **The communicants.** The usual Lutheran preparation was not a general confession at all, but each communicant's private confession, examination and absolution on the Saturday or before the service. The general confession was never allowed to replace it in Brandenburg (§3.4.6; the private rite is treated in Chapter 13 §13.17).

3.4.3 Old texts or new?

The Latin *Confiteor*. No evangelical order in Sehling prints the Roman *Confiteor* (I confess). Where it is kept it is the priest's private prayer, and the text is assumed (§3.3.2). Hohenlohe 1553 wants "the pure Confiteor in Latin"; Brandenburg-Nürnberg allows "the Confiteor, or what his devotion puts him in mind of".

New confessions. Every public confession in the corpus is a new text. There are five families of wording:

Family	Incipit	Orders
Döber–Mecklenburg	"And I, poor sinful man, confess unto God Almighty, my Maker and Redeemer, that I have sinned not only with thoughts, words or works …"	Döber 1525, Lippe, Kiel, Mecklenburg 1540, 1552, Pfalz-Zweibrücken 1557, Pfalz-Veldenz 1574
Volprecht	"I, poor, wretched, sinful man, confess myself unto God my heavenly Father … you brothers and sisters …"	Volprecht 1524
Naumburg	"I, poor sinner, confess unto thee, O almighty God and merciful Father, before this whole congregation all my sins and misdeeds …"	Naumburg 1537
Württemberg	"I, poor sinner, confess myself unto God, my heavenly Father, that I have, alas, sinned grievously and manifoldly, not only with outward, gross sins, but much more with inward, inborn blindness …"	Württemberg 1536; Kurpfalz 1556; Palatinate 1563 (Reformed; in the second person, "before thee, my God and Maker")
Strasbourg	"Almighty, everlasting God and Father, we confess and acknowledge unto thee that we were conceived in unrighteousness …"	Strasbourg 1537 (Moderate Reformed); Palatinate 1563 (Reformed; prayer before the sermon); Poullain and Micron (Reformed)

Bugenhagen's Brunswick confession of 1528 is a sixth, unique form: a confession against the Creed and the two tables of the law, with a pause for each to name his own sin (§3.4.4).

The confession's two points. The Döber family confesses actual sin "in thoughts, words or works: the *cogitatione, verbo et opere* of the *Confiteor" *and* original sin, "conceived and born in sins". Württemberg confesses "inward inborn blindness, unbelief, doubt". Both make original sin and unbelief the matter of the confession.

What became of the *Misereatur*. The Roman "Almighty God have mercy upon thee" is said by the server for the priest and by the priest for the server. In the orders:

- **Kept by name.** At Kiel: "the minister reads the Misereatur; the sexton reads the Misereatur". The text is not given.
- **Recast as a prayer for us all.** Döber: "The merciful God vouchsafe to have mercy upon us …". Lippe heads this same prayer "The absolution".
- **Given to the second minister.** In Mecklenburg 1540 "the minister answereth this prayer", as the server answered the priest's *Confiteor* with the *Misereatur* (May [almighty God] have mercy). In 1552 it becomes a full collect, "O almighty, merciful God, who hast given thine only-begotten Son unto death for us, vouchsafe to have mercy upon us …".
- **The name given to a declaration.** Volprecht heads his absolution "Absolution, the Misereatur" (§3.3.5).

What became of the *Indulgentiam*. The Roman "May the almighty and merciful Lord grant us pardon, absolution and remission of our sins" is a wish in the first person plural. Two orders keep its opening words:

- **Kantz 1522**: "The almighty and merciful God forgive you your sins!", in the second person, followed by the indicative absolution.
- **Döber 1525**: "The almighty, merciful God hath had mercy upon us …", recast as a declaration in the perfect tense.

3.4.4 Optative, declaratory or indicative?

The absolutions fall into five types. The modern Common Service declaration of grace is type 2.

Type	Formula	Orders
1. Optative (a wish or prayer)	"The merciful God vouchsafe to have mercy upon us and forgive us our sins …"	Döber 1525 (the *Misereatur* [May almighty God have mercy]); Lippe and Kiel; Mecklenburg 1540; Mecklenburg 1552 and Pfalz-Zweibrücken 1557 (as the second minister's prayer)
2. Declaration of grace (first person plural, no "I")	"The almighty, merciful God hath had mercy upon us … God grant this unto us all"	Döber 1525; Mecklenburg 1540 and 1552; Pfalz-Zweibrücken 1557; Pfalz-Veldenz 1574; Volprecht 1524 ("God hath had mercy upon us")
3. Indicative (the minister, by Christ's command, looses)	"I, by the commandment of our Lord Jesus Christ, in the stead of the holy Church, pronounce you free, quit and loosed"	Kantz 1522; Kiel (read by the sexton); Naumburg 1537; Württemberg 1536; Nürnberg after 1569; Mecklenburg 1552 (in the exhortation)
4. Conditional declaration, with retention	"As many of you as … to them I declare … But as many among you as still have pleasure in their sins …"	Strasbourg 1537 (Moderate Reformed; without retention); Micron and Palatinate 1563 (Reformed)
5. No absolution, only a word of comfort	"Jesus Christ is our salvation for ever"	Bugenhagen, Brunswick 1528; Palatinate 1563 (Reformed; Supper examination)

Type 2 and type 3. The declaration of grace (type 2) is the commonest form at the *beginning* of the Mass. The indicative (type 3) is the commonest form in the *communion rite*, where it comes out of private confession. The orders do not argue over the difference. Württemberg 1536 offers both, and in the second person singular.

Württemberg 1536: the open confession and three absolutions. After the exhortation the pastor says the confession for all, then one of three absolutions; the congregation then sings the Our Father "as a public confession". **Württemberg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1536** (Sehling 16, pp. 108–109):

After the exhortation he shall say before them the public confession, and afterward the public absolution, about after this manner: I, poor sinner, confess myself unto God my heavenly Father, that I have, alas, grievously and manifoldly sinned, not only with outward, gross sins, but much more with inward, inborn blindness, unbelief, doubting, faint-heartedness, impatience, pride, evil lusts, secret envy and hatred, grudging, etc., as my Lord God knoweth of me, and I, alas, cannot so perfectly know; therefore they repent me and are grievous unto me; I desire grace of God. Absolution: The almighty God hath had mercy upon thee, and through the merit of the most holy passion, death and resurrection of our Lord Jesus Christ, his beloved Son, he forgiveth thee all thy sins; and I, as an appointed minister of the Christian Church, declare unto thee, by the command of our Lord Jesus Christ, such forgiveness of all thy sins, in the name of the Father and of the Son and of the Holy Ghost, Amen. Go in peace; be it unto thee as thou believest. Or thus: The almighty and merciful God forgiveth thee thy sin, and I, by the command of our Lord Jesus Christ, in the stead of the holy Church, pronounce thee free, quit and loosed of all thy sins, in the name of the Father and of the Son and of the Holy Ghost, Amen. Go, and sin no more, but amend thyself without ceasing; God help thee thereto. Or thus: In the institution of the preaching office of the holy Gospel, Jesus Christ said to his apostles: He that heareth you heareth me; and whose soever sins ye remit, they are remitted, and whose soever ye retain, they are retained. By virtue of these words and command of Christ I declare unto you that all your sins are atoned through Jesus Christ, and I remit you, as an ordained minister of the holy Gospel, all your misdeeds, in the name of the Father, of the Son and of the Holy Ghost, Amen. Thereupon let the church sing the Our Father in German, for it is a singularly hearty prayer, and therewith also a public confession.

Note.

- **The second person singular.** The first two absolutions are in the singular ("thee"), as in private confession. Sehling's editor refers both to the absolution of private confession in Brandenburg-Nürnberg 1533 (Sehling 11, p. 187). Only the third is in the plural.
- **The confession** passes, almost word for word, into the Kurpfalz order of 1556 and from it into the Reformed Palatinate order of 1563 (below).
- **The Our Father** sung after the absolution is called "a public confession" because of its fifth petition.

Nürnberg after 1569: the *Offene Schuld* appended to the exhortation. Veit Dietrich's *Agendbüchlein* (agenda booklet), in the editions from 1569, ends the exhortation with an invitation to confess and an absolution that is both conditional and indicative. **Nürnberg, Veit Dietrich, *Agendbüchlein*, edition of 1569, from Sehling's apparatus** (Sehling 11, p. 498):

And forasmuch as we have all sinned and have need of the grace of God, humble your hearts before God the Lord, confess your sins and infirmities with hearty love and desire of his divine grace and help, with firm faith and trust in his gracious promise, and forgive from the heart every one his neighbour, that your heavenly Father may also forgive your sins and misdeeds! If ye do this, I loose you, in the stead of the holy Christian Church and by the command and promise of our Lord Jesus Christ, when he said, "Whose soever sins ye remit, they are remitted unto them" (John 20:23), from all your sins, in the name of the Father and of the Son and of the Holy Ghost. Amen.

Editor's note (p. 498, note 5). The *Offene Schuld* (open confession) "had been appended in the winter of 1524/25 on the model of the medieval preaching service". Osiander left it out when the exhortation was taken into the church order of 1533; "at the congregation's wish" it was quickly taken back, and "Osiander now waged a hot but vain battle against it". The wording disputed in 1533 came from Wenzel Linck.

Bugenhagen, Brunswick 1528: the confession from the pulpit. After the sermon the preacher leads the people in the Creed and a confession of sins, without an absolution. The general prayer follows. **Brunswick, *Christlike ordeninge* of Johannes Bugenhagen, 1528** (Sehling 6/1, p. 443):

Exhortation or admonition on the pulpit after the sermon: Dear friends in Christ, say the Creed with me. I believe in God the Father almighty, etc. Say the confession with me, and confess your sins unto God, that God may be gracious unto us. God be merciful to me a poor sinner. I fail in faith, in that I love not God my Lord with my whole heart, nor rely wholly upon him in temptations and in all need of body and soul. I should fear God alone and have him before mine eyes in all things; now I fear the people that can do me evil for righteousness' sake. I fear to lose my goods, honour, friendship and life. I am careful for my living unchristianly, and seek in all things mine own and not what is God's. Also I set not my salvation wholly in Jesus Christ, his only-begotten Son, given for us. I fail also in love, in that I love not my neighbour as myself, but deal against him with evil suspicions, with backbiting, with words, with works, and cannot suffer one word from him against me. Much more I keep silence, and cannot forgive him from the heart, and yet am bound so to do. In especial I have a burdened conscience in this temptation: N., in this sin: N. (Let every one complain to God of his secret grievous sin, for amendment.) Therefore, almighty God, dear Father, forgive me all my sins, and enlighten my heart with thy truth, that I may hold thee for my gracious Father and my neighbour for my brother, without all offence, according to thy word, through our Lord Jesus Christ. (Say:) Amen. Jesus Christ is our salvation for ever. (Say:) Amen.

Note.

- **"N."** marks a silent pause in which each hearer names his own temptation and sin to God.
- **The ending.** There is no absolution: the preacher's "Jesus Christ is our salvation for ever" stands in its place.

Amberg 1550: the open confession with the general prayer. In the Upper Palatinate the open confession follows the sermon on Sundays, together with the general prayer, and comes before the offertory and the exhortation. At weekday morning prayer the people say it after the priest. **Amberg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1550** (Sehling 13, pp. 286–287):

Thereupon followeth the sermon, which is commonly begun with the Creed or with another German psalm or hymn of the high feasts. After the sermon there is always spoken the open confession and the common prayer for spiritual and temporal [estates], and else for all the pressing need of the Christian Church. […] The priest readeth before the altar, toward the people, a whole chapter out of the Bible, with a short summary or exposition; thereafter the open confession and the common prayer, with the morning blessing, which the people [say] after him; lastly a collect and a German psalm.

The Palatinate 1563: confession, absolution and retention after the sermon. The Reformed order puts the confession after the Sunday morning sermon. Its confession is Württemberg's, and its absolution is a conditional declaration with a retention of sins. **Palatinate, *Kirchenordnung*, 1563** (Reformed; Sehling 14, p. 389):

On Sunday after the morning sermon the minister of the church shall say: Ye beloved in the Lord, forasmuch as we see in the commandments of God, as in a glass, how great and manifold our sins are, whereby we deserve temporal and eternal punishment, let us confess the same from the heart unto our faithful Father; say therefore with me thus: I, poor sinner, confess before thee, my God and Creator, that I have, alas, grievously and manifoldly sinned against thee, not only with outward gross sins, but much more with inward inborn blindness, unbelief, doubting, faint-heartedness, impatience, pride, evil covetousness, secret envy, hatred and grudging, and other evil tricks, as thou, my Lord and God, knowest of me, and I, alas, cannot sufficiently know; they repent me and are grievous unto me, and I desire grace from the heart, through thy dear Son Jesus Christ. Thereupon he shall declare unto the faithful the forgiveness of sins, and unto the impenitent the judgment of God, and speak thus: Now hear the sure comfort of the grace of God, which he promiseth to all the faithful in his Gospel. Thus saith the Lord Christ, John 3: God so loved the world, that he gave his only-begotten Son, that whosoever believeth in him should not perish, but have everlasting life. As many of you, then, as have displeasure in themselves and in their sins, and trust that they are wholly and altogether forgiven them through the merit of Jesus Christ alone, and have the purpose more and more to abstain from sins and to serve the Lord in true holiness and righteousness, to them (since they believe in the Son of the living God) I declare by the command of God that they are loosed in heaven from all their sins (as he promiseth in his holy Gospel) through the perfect satisfaction of the most holy passion and death of our Lord Jesus Christ, Amen. But as many among you as still have pleasure in their sins and shame, or persevere in sins against their conscience, to them I declare by the command of God that the wrath and judgment of God abideth upon them, and that all their sins are retained in heaven, and that they cannot be loosed from eternal damnation until they be converted.

Note.

- **The editor's sources.** "almost word for word from Kurpfalz 1556" for the confession, and London 1565 (à Lasco and Micron's order, Reformed) for the address.
- **John 3:16** is the Strasbourg *Trostspruch* (1537, Moderate Reformed; §3.3.6). Kurpfalz 1556 uses it as the absolution in the communion of the sick (Sehling 14, p. 171).
- **The verbs.** "I declare … that they are loosed in heaven" is a declaration, not a loosing: the minister announces what God has done, as in type 2, but to a defined class of hearers, with a retention for the rest.

The Palatinate's Supper examination. Before the Supper the Reformed Palatinate (1563) puts three questions (on sin, redemption and thankfulness), each answered "Yes", and closes with an assurance in place of an absolution. **Palatinate, *Kirchenordnung*, 1563** (Reformed; Sehling 14, p. 383):

All, then, that find this in their heart, let them not doubt that through the holy passion and death of Christ they already have the forgiveness of all their sins and surely keep it, so long as they persevere in this purpose, notwithstanding that there are yet many remaining infirmities in them, which nevertheless are covered with the same passion and death of Jesus Christ. Thereupon let every one that desireth this from the heart say: Amen. Kneel down and pray as the Lord hath taught us: Our Father, etc. After the prayer let the minister of the church say: The God of peace sanctify you wholly, and your whole spirit, soul and body be preserved blameless unto the coming of our Lord Jesus Christ. Faithful is he that calleth you, who also will do it, Amen.

3.4.5 The public confession and the modern Common Service

The Common Service of 1888, and the American Lutheran books that followed it, open the service with a confession of sins and a declaration of grace. Their texts descend directly from the Mecklenburg family (§3.3.4). The English below is quoted from the Common Service as printed. It is not in Sehling, and is given here for comparison only, so it is not set as a verified quotation.

Mecklenburg 1552 / Pfalz-Zweibrücken 1557	Common Service (1888)
"My dearest in God, open your hearts; let us confess our sins unto God, and pray for forgiveness in the name of our Lord Jesus Christ."	"Beloved in the Lord! Let us draw near with a true heart, and confess our sins unto God our Father, beseeching Him, in the Name of our Lord Jesus Christ, to grant us forgiveness."

Mecklenburg 1552 / Pfalz-Zweibrücken 1557	Common Service (1888)
"Our help standeth in the name of the Lord. *The choir answereth.* Who hath made heaven and earth."	"Our help is in the Name of the Lord. *R.* Who made heaven and earth."
(Döber, Mecklenburg 1540: "Confess unto the Lord, for he is good. *Answer.* And his mercy is everlasting.")	"I said, I will confess my transgressions unto the Lord. *R.* And Thou forgavest the iniquity of my sin." (Ps 32:5)
"I, poor sinful man, confess before thee, O almighty God, my Maker and Redeemer, that I have sinned, not only with thoughts, words and works, but that I am also by nature sinful and unclean … But I have refuge unto thy bottomless mercy, and seek and desire grace, for the Lord Jesus Christ's sake."	"Almighty God, our Maker and Redeemer, we poor sinners confess unto Thee, that we are by nature sinful and unclean, and that we have sinned against Thee by thought, word, and deed. Wherefore we flee for refuge to Thine infinite mercy, seeking and imploring Thy grace, for the sake of our Lord Jesus Christ."
The other minister: "O almighty, merciful God, who hast given thine only-begotten Son unto death for us, vouchsafe to have mercy upon us, and for the sake of the same thy beloved Son forgive us all our sins; and give us also thy Holy Ghost, who may kindle and increase in us true knowledge of thy divine being and will, and true obedience toward thee; that we may attain eternal life through thy grace …"	"O most merciful God, who hast given Thine Only-begotten Son to die for us, have mercy upon us, and for His sake grant us remission of all our sins; and by Thy Holy Spirit increase in us true knowledge of Thee, and of Thy will, and true obedience to Thy Word, to the end that by Thy grace we may come to everlasting life; through Jesus Christ our Lord."
The priest: "The almighty, merciful God hath had mercy upon us, forgiveth us truly all our sins for his dear Son's sake, whom he hath given unto death for our sake, and hath given power to become the children of God to all that believe on his name; he giveth us thereto his Holy Ghost; whoso believeth and is baptized shall be saved. God grant this unto us all"	"Almighty God, our Heavenly Father, hath had mercy upon us, and hath given His Only Son to die for us, and for His sake forgiveth us all our sins. To them that believe on His Name, He giveth power to become the sons of God, and bestoweth upon them His Holy Spirit. He that believeth, and is baptized, shall be saved. Grant this, O Lord, unto us all."

What the comparison shows.

- **The order** of the Common Service preparation (address, *Adiutorium* [Our help], a second versicle, confession, prayer for forgiveness, declaration of grace) is Döber's order of 1525, by way of Mecklenburg.
- **The prayer for forgiveness** ("O most merciful God …") is the old *Misereatur* (May [almighty God] have mercy). In Mecklenburg 1552 it belonged to the *second minister* or custos kneeling beside the priest. That is the server's place in the Roman *Stufengebet* (prayers at the foot of the altar).
- **The declaration of grace** ("Almighty God … hath had mercy upon us … Grant this, O Lord, unto us all") is type 2 (§3.4.4): God's mercy declared in the third person, with no "I absolve", and closed with a wish. It is not an indicative absolution, and not the optative *Misereatur* either. Its final wish goes back to Döber's "God grant this unto us all".
- **The confession** passes from the priest's "I, poor sinful man" to "we poor sinners". The step is already taken at Amberg in 1555, where the priest, kneeling with another minister, says "We poor, sinful men confess before thee, O almighty God, our Creator and Redeemer" (Sehling 13, p. 290; §3.3.4). Marienhafe in East Frisia has a plural prayer of confession too, "we poor, sinful men confess and lament unto thee with sorrowful hearts our manifold sins and misdeeds" (Sehling 7/1, p. 712), but it comes from another line, the *Offene Schuld* (open confession) of the Engerhafe liturgy, and stands before communion. In the sixteenth-century orders the priest says it alone while the people keep silence and confess in their hearts; the Common Service gives it to the congregation.
- **The second versicle.** The Common Service's second versicle (Ps 32:5) is not in Sehling's Mecklenburg texts. Its place is taken in Döber and Mecklenburg 1540 by *Confitemini Domino*.

The indicative absolution in American Lutheran books. The other common form in American Lutheran books, "Upon this your confession, I, by virtue of my office, as a called and ordained servant of the Word, announce the grace of God unto all of you, and in the stead and by the command of my Lord Jesus Christ I forgive you all your sins …", has its sixteenth-century counterpart in Naumburg 1537: "Upon such your confession, by the commandment of the Lord Jesus Christ, in the stead of the holy Christian church, I forgive you all your sins" (§3.3.5). Its confession is also close to the one that goes with this absolution in those books: "O almighty God, merciful Father, I, a poor, miserable sinner, confess unto Thee all my sins and iniquities … and I pray Thee of Thy

boundless mercy and for the sake of the holy, innocent, bitter sufferings and death of Thy beloved Son, Jesus Christ, to be gracious and merciful to me". Compare Naumburg's "pray thee, by thy bottomless mercy and by the bitter sufferings and death of thy dear Son JESUS CHRIST, that thou wouldest be gracious unto me, poor sinner". Württemberg's "as an appointed minister of the Christian Church" is the sixteenth-century form of "a called and ordained servant of the Word".

3.4.6 General confession against private confession

The Brandenburg-Nürnberg tradition was wary of the general confession. The Brandenburg order forbids the people to replace private confession with a confession said together. **Brandenburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1540** (Sehling 3, p. 60):

Likewise the abuse that hath been taken up in some places, that several persons together in a crowd make a common confession and receive a public absolution, and let it rest there, shall not be suffered; but every one shall be heard and absolved severally, as need requireth. And that it may now go orderly and rightly, and all abuses be prevented as far as possible, the people shall be told that whoso will receive the holy sacrament shall [announce himself] the evening before, or, where that could not be by reason of the distance of the way or other chances, in the morning before the time of Mass, to the pastor [...].

Pfalz-Neuburg 1543 repeats the rule: the pastors shall "not suffer many of them to make a common confession together, but every one shall make his confession for himself and desire absolution" (Sehling 13, p. 57).

The point of the prohibition. It is not aimed at a confession in the Mass. Brandenburg 1540 itself has the priest's *Confiteor* (I confess) at the altar (§3.3.2). It is aimed at groups of communicants confessing together on the Saturday and taking that for private confession. In the Nürnberg tradition, the general absolution in the Mass was itself contested in 1533 (§3.4.4). Where both exist, as in Mecklenburg, the public confession at the start of the Mass is a preparation for all, and the private confession on the Saturday is the condition of admission to communion.

3.5 The exhortation to the communicants: the families collated

3.5.1 Where it falls, and what it is for

What it is. Every Lutheran order with a communion rite has an exhortation (*Vermahnung*, *vormaninge*, *exhortatio*) addressed to the communicants. Bugenhagen calls it "the true Preface, that is, a foreword" (Brunswick 1528, Sehling 6/1, p. 440). It does four things:

- it teaches what the Sacrament is;
- it calls the communicants to examine themselves (1 Cor 11:28);
- it rehearses or paraphrases the Words of Institution;
- it calls for thanksgiving and love of the neighbour.

It never replaces the Words of Institution, which are always sung or said after it. In Nürnberg, where the exhortation itself rehearsed the Verba, Sehling notes that once the Verba were sung aloud the exhortation "doubled" them.

Placement. The exhortation stands in five places:

Place	Orders
After the sermon, in the pulpit or at the altar, before the Our Father and Verba	Luther, *Deutsche Messe* 1526 (pulpit or altar left free); Saxony 1539 and 1580; Mansfeld 1562; Grubenhagen 1581; Henneberg 1582
At the altar after the sermon, before the Verba	Brandenburg-Nürnberg 1533 (moved there "at Luther's suggestion"); Württemberg 1536 and its family; Pfalz-Neuburg 1543; Hohenlohe; Verden 1606; Palatinate 1563 (Reformed; at the table)
At the altar after the sermon, before the Preface (as its "true" form)	Bugenhagen, Brunswick 1528, Hamburg 1529, Wolfenbüttel 1543, Hildesheim 1544; Kantz 1522
After the Preface and Sanctus, before the Our Father and Verba	Mecklenburg 1552 ("if there is time"); Osnabrück 1543; Naumburg 1537 (before the Sanctus)

Place	Orders
After the Verba and Our Father, before communion	Nürnberg 1524, Döber 1525, *Form und Ordnung* 1525 (Osiander's original place)
After communion	Memmingen 1528 (Moderate Reformed) and Marienhafe 1593 (a short exhortation to love and thanksgiving)

Editor's note on the move. Sehling's editor comments on Brandenburg-Nürnberg 1533 (Sehling 11, p. 195): "the transposition, compared with 1524, to before the beginning of the sacramental part goes back to Luther's suggestion in his *Deutsche Messe".

Who reads it. The priest, facing the people, from the altar (most orders), or the preacher from the pulpit (Luther's option; Bugenhagen's pulpit exhortation; Micron, Reformed). In Nürnberg 1525 "the priest or the minister" may read it.

3.5.2 The families and their witnesses

How the collation was made. Every exhortation in the corpus was located by scanning all 2,368 documents for passages that share wording with a known exhortation. The match tolerates the spelling differences between High German, Low German and the several regional spellings. Each witness found was then aligned word by word against the archetype of its family, and every difference longer than a spelling variant was listed and read. Sehling's apparatus and footnotes, which the database prints inside the running text, were set aside by hand.

What "archetype" means here. For each family the archetype is the earliest full text printed by Sehling from which the others descend. Where a later recension was copied more widely than the archetype (Württemberg 1553, the Braunschweig recension of Osiander), its changes are set out in full.

The families. There are eleven families with more than one witness, and a handful of exhortations that occur in one order only:

§	Family (archetype)	Incipit	Witnesses in Sehling
3.5.3	**Luther**, Wittenberg 1526	"Dear friends of Christ, forasmuch as we are here gathered together …"	Saxony 1539 (abridged in print), Prussia 1544 and 1568 (in place of the Preface), Albertine Saxony 1580, Mansfeld 1562, Grubenhagen 1581, Lindau 1573, Wertheim c. 1555 (as a prayer), Frankfurt 1543 and the French church at Frankfurt 1585 (Reformed; paraphrase only), Henneberg 1582 (admonition only, rewritten)
3.5.4	**Osiander**, Nürnberg 1524	"Ye dearly beloved in God! Forasmuch as we will now … the supper …"	Volprecht 1524, Nürnberg parish churches 1524, Döber 1525, *Form und Ordnung* 1525; the Braunschweig recension: Lüneburg 1564, Braunschweig-Wolfenbüttel 1569, Buxtehude 1565 (Low German, cited), Lippe 1571, Lüneburg 1575 (cited), Verden 1606, Waldeck (revised text B)
3.5.5	**Brandenburg-Nürnberg** 1533	"Dearly beloved in God, forasmuch as we will now … the holy Supper …"	Brandenburg 1540, Calenberg-Göttingen 1542, Regensburg c. 1544 (rewritten 1567), Dietrich's *Agendbüchlein* 1543 (cited), Pfalz-Neuburg 1543, Schwäbisch Hall 1543, Hohenlohe 1553 and 1578, Strasbourg 1553 (Marbach), Nassau-Dillenburg 1575 (Philippist; cited), Erbach 1587, Ysenburg-Birstein 1588
3.5.6	**Württemberg** 1536, revised 1553	"Dearly beloved in Christ Jesus, forasmuch as we will now … the gracious Supper …"	1536 text: Worms 1560. 1553 text: Kurpfalz 1556, Worms 1560, Leiningen-Westerburg 1566, Lindau 1573, Hanau-Lichtenberg 1573, Nassau-Weilburg 1576 (in its Agende of 1618), Ysenburg-Ronneburg 1582, Strasbourg 1598, Isny c. 1600, Solms-Laubach 1603, Wild- und Rheingrafschaft 1603

§	Family (archetype)	Incipit	Witnesses in Sehling
3.5.7	**Bugenhagen**, Brunswick 1528	"My dearly beloved, it is continually set before us by the preaching of the Gospel …"	Low German: Hamburg 1529, Lübeck 1531 (cited), Hadeln (cited), Wolfenbüttel 1543, Osnabrück 1543 (cited), Hildesheim 1544 (cited), Buxtehude (cited), Hamburg 1556 (cited). High German: Frankfurt 1543 (free paraphrase), Lüneburg 1564, Hildesheim 1561 (cited), Braunschweig-Wolfenbüttel 1569, Lippe 1571 (twice), Verden 1606, Osnabrück 1613 (abridged)
3.5.8	**Naumburg** 1537	"Dear friends, forasmuch as ye are now … the testament of our dear Lord Jesus Christ …"	Nördlingen 1579 (and, according to Sehling's editor, Nördlingen 1544)
3.5.9	**Mecklenburg** 1552	"Dear friends, ye that as Christian men have been instructed beforehand concerning God …"	Pfalz-Zweibrücken 1557, Nassau-Weilburg 1576, Sayn 1590 (abridged); its prayer in Pfalz-Veldenz 1574
3.5.10	**The Palatinate** 1563 (Reformed)	"Ye beloved in the Lord Jesus Christ, hear the words of the institution …"	Ysenburg-Birstein 1598; the Lower Rhine recension: Moers 1581, Bentheim-Tecklenburg 1588/1619 (all Reformed)
3.5.11	**Pfalz-Veldenz** 1574	"Ye beloved in the Lord Christ. It is well known to you as Christians, out of God's word …"	Lützelstein 1605
3.5.12	**Zürich and Basel** (Reformed)	"Dear brethren! Ye have heard the unspeakable mercy of God …"	Memmingen 1528 (Moderate Reformed; from Zürich 1525), Neckarbischofsheim 1560 (from Basel 1526)
3.5.13	**Strasbourg** (Moderate Reformed)	"Dear brothers and sisters, ye will every one consider with himself …"	the early Strasbourg agendas; its second half in Memmingen 1528 (both Moderate Reformed)

The exhortations that belong to no family (Kantz 1522 and the Bremen Mass of 1525, Augsburg 1530 (Moderate Reformed), Buxtehude 1565, Micron 1554/1565 (Reformed), Marienhafe 1593, and the Saturday exhortations of Hohenlohe 1578) are treated in §3.5.14.

Not reproducible. Mecklenburg 1540/45 has three Low German exhortations, "one of these three exhortations to be read at a time". Sehling does not print them: "There follow three exhortations to the Supper, the second of which is freely shaped after the only one in the Low German edition of the Brandenburg-Nürnberg order" (Sehling 5, p. 154.) Weißenburg 1528 meant to print the Nürnberg exhortation but, as the editor notes, "it was then forgotten to include it" (Sehling 11, p. 659).

3.5.3 The Luther family: Wittenberg, *Deutsche Messe*, 1526

Luther joins a paraphrase of the Our Father to a short admonition on the testament, and leaves it free whether it is read from the pulpit or at the altar. **Wittenberg, Luther, *Deudsche messe und ordnung gottis diensts*, 1526** (Sehling 1, p. 15):

After the sermon shall follow a public paraphrase of the Our Father and an admonition to them that will go to the sacrament, after this or a better manner, as followeth: Dear friends of Christ, forasmuch as we are here gathered together in the name of the Lord to receive his holy testament, I admonish you first that ye lift up your heart to God, to pray with me the Our Father, as Christ

our Lord hath taught us and hath comfortably promised us a hearing. That God our Father in heaven would mercifully look upon us his wretched children on earth, and grant grace that his holy name may be hallowed among us and in all the world, through the pure and upright teaching of his word and through the fervent love of our life; would graciously turn away all false teaching and evil life, whereby his worthy name is blasphemed and put to shame. That his kingdom also may come and be increased; that he would bring all sinners, the blinded, and them that are taken captive by the devil in his kingdom, to the knowledge of the right faith in Jesus Christ his Son, and make the number of Christians great. That we also may be strengthened with his Spirit to do and to suffer his will, both in life and in death, in good and in evil, always breaking, offering up and slaying our own will. That he would also give us our daily bread, keep us from covetousness and care for the belly, but let us look to him for enough of all good things. That he would also forgive us our debts, as we forgive our debtors, that our heart may have a sure and joyful conscience before him, and never fear nor be afraid of any sin. That he would not lead us into temptation, but help us by his Spirit to subdue the flesh, despise the world with all its ways, and overcome the devil with all his wiles. And lastly, that he would deliver us from all evil, both bodily and spiritual, temporal and eternal. Whoso earnestly desire all this, let them say from the heart: "Amen", believing without all doubt that it is yea and heard in heaven, as Christ promiseth us: "What ye ask, believe that ye shall have it, and it shall be done." Amen. Secondly, I admonish you in Christ that ye give heed with right faith to the testament of Christ, and above all hold fast in your heart the words wherein Christ giveth us his body and blood for forgiveness; that ye remember and give thanks for the bottomless love which he hath shown us, when he redeemed us by his blood from God's wrath, sin, death and hell; and thereupon take outwardly unto you the bread and wine, that is, his body and blood, for assurance and pledge. Accordingly we will, in his name and by his command, through his own words, so handle and use the testament. But whether this paraphrase and admonition be done in the pulpit straight after the sermon, or before the altar, I leave free to every one's choice. It seemeth that the ancients have done it hitherto in the pulpit, whence it hath still remained that the common prayer is made in the pulpit, or the Our Father said before [the people]. But the admonition hath become a public confession.

Note.

- **The two parts.** The paraphrase is a prayer, said by the minister, to which the people answer "Amen". The admonition proper is the second paragraph.
- **The pulpit.** Luther's last sentences give the history: the medieval pulpit office (*Prone*) had a bidding prayer, the Our Father, and an admonition that "has become a public confession", the *Offene Schuld* (open confession) of §3.3.5.

The witnesses.

Order	Sehling	Form
Saxony (Albertine), *Kirchenordnung*, 1539	1, p. 274	Full, but Sehling prints only incipit and explicit, "Dear friends of Christ, forasmuch as we are here gathered … so handle and use the testament"; headed "Vermanung zum gebet vor der communio" (Exhortation to prayer before the communion). The Our Father and Verba may be sung in its place.
Prussia, *Kirchenordnung*, 1544	4, p. 65	Read "in place of the Preface, which shall be done away"; paraphrase as Luther, only lacking "grace"; admonition rewritten (below)
Prussia, *Kirchenordnung und ceremonien*, 1568	4, pp. 81–82	The 1544 form, printed in full, again in place of the Preface
Wertheim, *Kirchenordnung*, c. 1555	11, pp. 713–714	Paraphrase turned into a prayer to God in the second person (below)
Mansfeld, *Kirchenordnung*, 1562	2, p. 227	Verbatim; optional
Lindau, *Kirchenordnung*, 1573	12, pp. 209–210	Verbatim, modernized optatives ("wölle" for "wolte"); said at the altar after the Württemberg exhortation from the pulpit (§3.5.6)
Oldenburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1573	7/2.1, pp. 1090–1091	Verbatim; "before the altar", or a Latin Preface instead
Albertine Saxony, *Kirchenordnung*, 1580	1, pp. 368–369	Verbatim; headed "Vermanung zum gebet vor der communion", read "before the altar"

Order	Sehling	Form
Grubenhagen, *Kirchenordnung*, 1581	6/2, p. 1075	Verbatim, with "his holy, precious" added in the admonition
Henneberg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1582	2, p. 308	Admonition only, rewritten (below)
Frankfurt, *Agende* for baptism and the communion of the sick, 1543	9, pp. 521, 553	Paraphrase as a prayer ("we thy wretched children on earth pray thee"); new admonition
Frankfurt, French Reformed church, *Diakonieordnung*, 1585 (Reformed)	9, p. 497	Paraphrase only, from the draft of the order

The significant variants.

- **No witness changes the paraphrase in substance** except by turning it into a direct prayer. The textual tradition of the paraphrase is stable: Saxony, Mansfeld, Oldenburg, Lindau, Albertine Saxony and Grubenhagen differ from Wittenberg only in spelling and in single words.
- **The paraphrase as a prayer.** Wertheim c. 1555 and Frankfurt 1543 recast Luther's indirect wishes ("that God our Father in heaven would …") as a prayer addressed to God. **Wertheim, *Kirchenordnung*, c. 1555** (Sehling 11, p. 713):

O God, our heavenly Father, vouchsafe mercifully to look upon us, thy poor, wretched children on earth, and grant grace that thy holy name may be hallowed among us and in all the world, through the pure and upright teaching of thy word and through the fervent amendment of our life.

Wertheim also reads "amendment of our life" for Luther's "love of our life".

- **Prussia: a declaration of forgiveness in the admonition.** The Prussian order keeps the paraphrase but opens the admonition with a conditional declaration of forgiveness and adds a sentence on personal appropriation. **Prussia, *Kirchenordnung*, 1544** (Sehling 4, p. 65):

Secondly, dear friends of Christ: forasmuch as ye hunger and thirst after the mercy of God and heartily desire the forgiveness of your sins, our Saviour Christ hath given his body and blood for you on the cross, that your sins shall be washed away, as many of you as believe it; therefore I admonish you in the Lord that ye give heed with right faith to the rich and holy testament of Christ, and above all rightly hold fast in your heart, by pure faith, the words wherein our Lord Christ giveth us his body and his precious blood for the forgiveness of sin; that ye remember his passion and death and thank him from the heart for the bottomless love which he hath shown us, when he redeemed us by his own blood from God's wrath, sin, death and hell; and thereupon take outwardly unto you the bread and wine, that is, his body and blood, for assurance and pledge; for even as each one receiveth it for himself, so also hath he to comfort himself with the Gospel and with a gracious, reconciled God, and to take them to himself.

The order of 1568, which prints the whole paraphrase, reads "heiliger name" for Luther's "werder name" (Sehling 4, p. 82).

- **Henneberg: the admonition alone.** The Henneberg order drops the paraphrase. It rewrites the admonition with a stronger statement of the presence ("his true body for a meat and his own blood for a drink, a phrase of the Württemberg exhortation") and the Johannine "that so Christ may live in you, and ye in Christ, for ever". **Henneberg, *Kirchenordnung* of Georg Ernst, 1582** (Sehling 2, p. 308):

Dear friends in Christ, forasmuch as we are here gathered in the name of the Lord to celebrate and receive the gracious Supper of our Lord Jesus Christ, I admonish you that ye give good heed with right earnestness and faith to the testament of Christ, and above all well consider in your heart the words (Take, eat, this is my body; drink, this is my blood) wherein Christ ordaineth us his true body for a meat and his own blood for a drink, and therewith giveth and reacheth forgiveness of sins, and hold them fast with faith; and thereafter humbly and devoutly thank the Lord Christ for the bottomless love which he hath shown us, when by the shedding of his blood and his death he redeemed us from God's wrath, sin, death and hell; and thereupon receive the bread and wine, that is, his body and blood, for a sure assurance, pledge and witness, that so Christ may live in you and ye in Christ for ever. Accordingly we will, in his name and by his command, through his own words, so handle and use the testament.

- **Use and option.** Mansfeld 1562 makes the whole text optional: "that whoever will may use it", and allows it to be dropped in towns when the singing and organ make the service too long (Sehling 2, p. 227). Saxony 1539 allows the Our Father and Verba to be sung instead. Oldenburg allows the Latin Preface instead.

3.5.4 The Osiander family: Nürnberg, 1524

The archetype. Andreas Osiander's exhortation was printed in the Nürnberg provosts' *Grundt und ursach* (1524). Sehling takes it as the base text of the order of the Nürnberg parish churches of 1524, with the variants of Volprecht (V), the parish churches (P) and Döber (D) in his apparatus. Osiander declared himself its author on 22 September 1533. It stood after the Verba, which were then still said in Latin, and served to "open" them to the people. **Nürnberg, *Gottesdienstordnung der Pfarrkirchen* (base text of *Grundt und ursach*), 1524** (Sehling 11, pp. 48–49):

Ye dearly beloved in God! Forasmuch as we will now consider and keep the supper of our Lord Jesus Christ, wherein his flesh and blood are given us for meat and for drink, not of the body but of the soul, we ought rightly with great diligence every one to examine himself, as Paul saith, and so to eat of this bread and drink of this cup. For none but a hungry soul, which knoweth its sin, feareth God's wrath and death, and is hungry and thirsty after righteousness, ought to receive this holy sacrament. But when we examine ourselves, we find nothing in us but sin and death, and can in no wise help ourselves out thereof. Therefore hath our dear Lord Jesus Christ had mercy upon us, and for our sakes is become man, that he might fulfil the law for us and suffer that which we had deserved with our sins. And that we might steadfastly believe this and joyfully rely thereupon, he took after the supper the bread, gave thanks, brake it, and said: Take and eat! This is my body, which is given for you; as if he would say: That I am become man, and all that I do and suffer, that is all your own, done for you and for your good. For a sure token thereof I give you my body for meat. Likewise also the cup, and said: Take and drink ye all of this! This is the cup of the new testament with my blood, which is shed for you and for many for the forgiveness of sins. As oft as ye do this, ye shall remember me thereby! As if he would say: Forasmuch as I have taken your cause upon me and laden your sins upon myself, I will offer myself unto death for sin, shed my blood, obtain grace and forgiveness of sins, and so set up a new testament, wherein sin shall be remembered no more for ever. For a sure token thereof I give you my blood to drink. Whosoever now eateth thus of this bread and drinketh of this cup, that is, whosoever firmly believeth these words which he heareth and these signs which he receiveth, he dwelleth in the Lord Christ and Christ in him, and so liveth for ever. Hereby shall we remember his death, give him thanks therefor, every one take up his cross and follow him, and above all love one another, as he also hath loved us; for we being many are one bread and one body, who are all partakers of one bread and drink of one cup.

The witnesses.

Order	Sehling	Form
Volprecht, *Deutsche Messe*, Nürnberg 1524 (V)	11, p. 48, apparatus	Full
Nürnberg parish churches, 1524 (P)	11, p. 48, apparatus	Full
Döber, *Deutsche Messe*, Nürnberg 1525 (D)	11, p. 54 (cited)	Full; text in Chapter 7 §7.8.7
Form und Ordnung einer christlichen Messe, Nürnberg 1525	11, p. 57 (cited)	Incipit only, "My dearly beloved in God etc."
Weißenburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1528	11, p. 659	Intended but left out by the printer
Lüneburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1564	6/1, pp. 546–547	Braunschweig recension, with a closing bidding to the Our Father
Buxtehude, *Agende*, 1565	7/1, p. 125	Low German, "My dearly beloved in God", given as "Another" after Buxtehude's own exhortation (§3.5.14.3); not printed by Sehling, who gives only the closing wish "God grant us all this, that we receive it worthily"

Order	Sehling	Form
Braunschweig-Wolfenbüttel, *Kirchenordnung*, 1569	6/1, pp. 146–147	Braunschweig recension, with the bidding
Lippe, *Kirchenordnung*, 1571	21, pp. 412–413	Braunschweig recension, with Döber's closing wish
Lüneburg (city), *Kirchenordnung*, 1575	6/1, p. 659	Incipit only: "as is further to be found in Dr. M. Luther's hymnal"
Verden, *Kirchenordnung*, 1606	7/1, pp. 158–159	Braunschweig recension, with the bidding
Waldeck, *Kirchenordnung*, revised text (B)	9, pp. 247–248, apparatus	Braunschweig recension, "if he have time"; the base text of 1556 has no exhortation

The Nürnberg variants, 1524–1525.

- **The address.** V, P and D all read "Mein allerliebsten" (My dearly beloved) for "Ir allerliebsten" (Ye dearly beloved).
- **Small differences.** V reads "high diligence" for "great". V, D read "pardon" for "forgiveness" of sins. V, P, D read "hold dear" for "love".
- **The closing wish.** D adds "God grant us all this, that we may receive it worthily. Amen". V adds "God grant it blessedly, amen".
- **The Offene Schuld.** In the winter of 1524/25 an open confession with absolution was added at the end; it was the subject of Osiander's dispute of 1533 (§3.4.4).

The Braunschweig recension. The Lower Saxon orders do not copy Brandenburg-Nürnberg 1533. They go back to the 1524 text in a recension first attested in Lüneburg 1564 and taken into the Braunschweig-Wolfenbüttel order of 1569. Lüneburg 1575 shows how it circulated: it was printed with Luther's hymnals. The recension changes the archetype in these places:

- **"forasmuch as we now [keep] the Supper of our dear Lord"** for "now the evening meal of our Lord".
- **"wherein his flesh is given us for a meat and his blood for a drink, not of the body but of the soul"**, restructuring "flesh and blood for meat and for drink".
- **"For none shall, but only a hungry soul"** for "For it shall not, but only a hungry soul".
- **"for a token thereof"**, dropping "sure" both times.
- **The Verba.** "do it in remembrance of me" for "ye shall remember me thereby". Braunschweig-Wolfenbüttel, Lippe and Waldeck B read the cup-word in the Pauline form, "this cup is the new testament in my blood".
- **"offer for sin"**, dropping "unto death".
- **"he abideth in Christ"**, dropping "the Lord" after it.
- **The ending.** "give him thanks from the heart, each take his cross upon him and follow the Lord, and above all things love one another, even as Christ hath loved us. For it is one bread and we, being many, one body, who are made partakers of one bread and all drink of one cup".
- **The bidding.** Lüneburg 1564, Braunschweig-Wolfenbüttel 1569 and Verden 1606 add a bidding to the Our Father (below). Lippe 1571 instead ends with Döber's "God grant us all this, that we receive it worthily. Amen".

Lüneburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1564 (Sehling 6/1, p. 547):

But that we may all together, according to the teaching and exhortation now heard, worthily receive the holy sacrament in right true faith and penitence, we will call upon God the Father in the name of Christ, and from the bottom of our heart say a devout Our Father.

Where it stands. In the Braunschweig recension the exhortation is read after the sermon and the general prayer, before the Preface (Lüneburg) or before the Our Father and Verba (Verden). In Lüneburg, Braunschweig-Wolfenbüttel, Lippe and Verden it is followed by Bugenhagen's exhortation as "another exhortation", to be used in its place (§3.5.7).

3.5.5 The Brandenburg-Nürnberg family, 1533

The archetype. The Brandenburg-Nürnberg order of 1533 revised Osiander's text (§3.5.4) and moved it before the Verba. This revised text is the most widely copied exhortation in the corpus. **Brandenburg-Nürnberg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1533** (Sehling 11, pp. 195–196):

Order of the Lord's Supper. When the priest will hold the Supper of the Lord (if he have communicants at all), he shall straightway make the following exhortation to the people, and then sing the words of the Supper, where the Mass is sung, about after the following manner and according to the notes set down hereafter; or, if he readeth the Mass, read them with loud and intelligible words, that they that stand about may hear them. The exhortation followeth. Dearly beloved in God, forasmuch as we will now consider and keep the holy Supper of our Lord Jesus Christ, wherein he hath given us his flesh for a meat and his blood for a drink, therewith to strengthen faith, we ought rightly with great diligence every one to examine himself, as the holy Paul exhorteth us; for this holy sacrament is given for a special comfort and strength to poor troubled consciences, which confess their sins, fear God's wrath and death, and are hungry and thirsty after righteousness. But when we examine ourselves, and every one goeth into his own conscience, as the holy Paul teacheth us, we shall surely find nothing else than all manner of horrible sins, and death, which we have deserved with sin, and yet can in no wise help ourselves out thereof. Therefore hath our dear Lord Jesus Christ had mercy upon us, and for our sins' sake is become man, that he might fulfil the law and all the will of God for us and for our good, and take upon himself and suffer death and all that we had deserved with our sins, for us and for our deliverance. And that we might steadfastly believe this, and through faith live joyfully in his will, he took after the supper the bread, gave thanks, brake it, and said: Take and eat! This is my body, which is given for you. That is: that I am become man, and all that I do and suffer, is all your own, done for you and for your good. For a sure token and witness thereof I give you my body for meat. Likewise he took also the cup and said: Take and drink ye all of this! This is the cup of the new testament in my blood, which is shed for you and for many for the forgiveness of sins. As oft as ye do this, ye shall remember me thereby. That is: forasmuch as I have taken your cause upon me and laden your sins upon myself, I will offer myself unto death for sin, shed my blood, obtain grace and forgiveness of sins, and so set up a new testament, wherein sins are forgiven and shall be remembered no more for ever. For a sure token and witness thereof I give you my blood to drink. Whosoever now eateth thus of this bread and drinketh of this cup, and firmly believeth these words which he heareth from Christ, and these signs which he receiveth from Christ, he dwelleth in the Lord Christ and Christ in him, and shall live for ever. Hereby shall we now remember him and show forth his death, namely that he died for our sins and rose again for our justification, and give him thanks therefor, every one take up his cross and follow him, and according to his commandment love one another, as he hath loved us: for we are all one bread and one body, forasmuch as we are all partakers of one bread and drink of one cup.

What 1533 changes in Osiander's text.

- **"holy Supper"** for "supper", and "wherein he hath given us his flesh for a meat and his blood for a drink, therewith to strengthen faith" for "not of the body but of the soul".
- **The comfort of consciences.** "this holy sacrament is given for a special comfort and strength to poor troubled consciences" replaces the rule that only a hungry soul "shall … receive".
- **Self-examination expanded:** "and every one go into his own conscience" and "all manner of horrible sins".
- **The work of Christ:** "fulfil the law and all the will of God", "for our deliverance".
- **"as if he would say"** becomes **"That is"** (That is) before each gloss.
- **"token and witness"** for "sign".
- **The ending.** "show forth his death, namely that he died for our sins and rose again for our justification" is added from Rom 4:25. Döber's closing wish is dropped.
- **No confession or absolution.** The Nürnberg editions from 1569 append the *Offene Schuld* (§3.4.4).

The witnesses.

Order	Sehling	Form and significant variants
Brandenburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1540	3, pp. 69–70	Verbatim except for a spelling of "now", and "the Supper" for "the holy Supper". Read after the consecration (Chapter 7 §7.12.6).
Calenberg-Göttingen, *Kirchenordnung*, 1542	6/2, pp. 790–791	Read on Saturdays and the eves of feasts "after confession has been made and absolution received", so it begins "forasmuch as we will tomorrow keep the Supper". "this sacrament is … given to poor, troubled and fainthearted consciences".

Order	Sehling	Form and significant variants
Regensburg, *Ein Christenliche vermanung, wie die zu Regenspurg alwegen vor der communion verlesen wird*, c. 1544	13, pp. 403–404	"his body for meat" for "his flesh for a meat"; the cup-word in the Pauline form ("this cup … this do, as oft as ye drink it, in remembrance of me"); "according to his command" for "commandment". Printed as the exhortation "that is made every Sunday before the communion". Followed by an open confession, "God be merciful to me a sinner", and an indicative absolution ("I declare unto you such forgiveness"). The order of 1553 has it read at the altar by the second minister after the Creed, citing this text (Sehling 13, p. 420).
Regensburg, *Vermanung vor der communion*, 1567	13, pp. 404–405	A new text on the same opening, "Ye beloved in God! Forasmuch as we will now keep the holy Supper of our Lord and Saviour Jesus Christ …", rewritten in three points (sin, Christ's fulfilment of the law, the bodily union with Christ in the Supper). It ends with the plural confession "God be merciful to us poor sinners" and the absolution "God hath had mercy upon you … which forgiveness I hereby declare unto you".
Nürnberg, Veit Dietrich, *Agendbüchlein*, 1543 and later editions	11, p. 498	Not reprinted: "word for word from the church order of 1533". From 1569 the *Offene Schuld* with an indicative absolution is appended to it (§3.4.4)
Pfalz-Neuburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1543	13, pp. 72–73	"that feel and confess their sins"; the cup-word lacks "which is shed for you and for many for the remission of sins". Text in Chapter 7 §7.14.1.
Schwäbisch Hall, *Kirchenordnung*, 1543	17/1, pp. 136–137	South-western subgroup (below)
Hohenlohe, *Kirchenordnung*, 1553	15, pp. 69–70	"will keep and receive the holy, most worthy sacrament of the body and blood of our Lord Jesus Christ" for "the holy Supper … consider and keep"; "these words … and these gifts which he receiveth" for "these signs". The manuscript lacks the transition to the open confession.
Strasbourg, *Kirchenordnung* of Marbach, 1553	20/1, p. 412	South-western subgroup; begins "Dear friends, forasmuch as we will now, by means of divine grace, keep the holy Supper"; read from the altar on Sundays between the psalms
Nassau-Dillenburg, *Agende*, 1575 (Philippist)	10, p. 151	Incipit only, "Ye dearly beloved in God etc."
Hohenlohe, *Kirchenordnung*, 1578	15, pp. 286–287	Verbatim (but "have" for "had")
Erbach, *Kirchenordnung*, 1587	9, pp. 436–437	South-western subgroup; "his body and blood for a spiritual meat and drink"; "supper" for "sacrament"; followed by the open confession
Ysenburg-Birstein, *Kirchenordnung*, 1588	10, pp. 626–627	Verbatim ("with all diligence" for "with great diligence")

The south-western subgroup. Schwäbisch Hall 1543, Strasbourg 1553 and Erbach 1587 share a set of changes that mark them as one recension:

- "forasmuch as we will now keep the Supper …", dropping "consider and";
- "his body" for "his flesh";
- "and every one goeth into his conscience", dropping "as Saint Paul teacheth us";
- "the law … fulfilled for us and for our good", dropping "and all the will of God";
- "he took the bread in the Supper" for "after the Supper";

- "and according to his commandment love one another, as he hath loved us, also …" and "are partakers of one bread".

  Württemberg 1553 also reads "in the Supper", where Württemberg 1536 had followed Brandenburg-Nürnberg's "after the Supper" (§3.5.6).

3.5.6 The Württemberg family, 1536 and 1553

The archetype. Württemberg 1536 takes the Brandenburg-Nürnberg text and expands it. It adds Augustine's sacraments as "visible words", a stronger statement of the presence ("my true, essential body"), and the Didache's figure of the grains and grapes. After it come the open confession, one of three absolutions, and the Our Father sung by the church (§3.4.4).
Württemberg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1536 (Sehling 16, pp. 107–108):

Dearly beloved in Christ Jesus, forasmuch as we will now celebrate and keep the gracious Supper of our dearest Saviour, wherein he hath given us his true body for a meat and his own blood for a drink, therewith to strengthen faith, we ought rightly with great diligence and fervent devotion to examine ourselves, as Saint Paul exhorteth; for forasmuch as poor feeble consciences may be comforted and strengthened, by means of the Holy Ghost, as well through the gracious sacraments, which are called by Saint Augustine visible words, as through the word, so far as it entereth in, therefore the gracious Supper is given for a special comfort and strength to troubled spirits and broken hearts, which confess their sins, fear and feel God's strict wrath and dreadful death, and are hungry after righteousness. But when we examine ourselves, and every one shall go into his own conscience, as the holy apostle here teacheth us, we shall surely find nothing else than all manner of great and perilous sin, and terrible death, which we have deserved with sin, and yet can in no wise help ourselves out thereof. Therefore hath our dear Lord Jesus Christ had mercy upon us, and for our sins' sake is become man, that he might fulfil the law and all the will of God for us, and take upon himself and suffer death, and also all that we had deserved with our sin, for us unto eternal redemption. And that we might steadfastly believe this, and through faith live joyfully and gladly in his will, he took after the supper the bread, gave thanks, brake it, and said: Take and eat, this is my body, which is given for you; (that is) that I am become man, and all that I do and suffer, is all your own, done for you and for your good; for a sure sign, seal and witness thereof I give you here with the bread my true, essential body. Likewise he took also the cup and said: Take and drink ye all thereof, this is the cup of the new testament in my blood, which is shed for you and for many for the forgiveness of sins; as oft as ye do this, ye shall remember me thereby; that is, forasmuch as I have taken your cause upon me and laden your sins upon myself, I will offer myself unto death for sin, shed my blood, obtain grace and forgiveness of sins, and so set up a new, everlasting testament, wherein sins are forgiven and shall never more be remembered for ever. For a sure pledge and everlasting witness thereof I give you my own essential and true blood to drink. Whosoever now eateth thus of this bread and drinketh of this cup, and firmly believeth these words which he here heareth from Christ and these signs which he receiveth from Christ, he dwelleth in the Lord Christ and Christ in him, and shall live for ever. Hereby shall we now remember him and show forth his death, namely that he died for our sins and rose again for our justification, and give him thanks therefor, every one take up his cross and follow him, and according to his commandment love one another, as he hath loved us; for we are all one bread and one body, forasmuch as we are all partakers of one bread and drink of one cup. For in like manner as out of many grapes pressed together one wine and one drink floweth and is mingled together, and out of many grains one meal is ground, and one bread and cake is baked, so shall we all, that are incorporated into Christ by faith, through brotherly love, for the sake of Christ our dearest Saviour, who first loved us so highly, become all one body, drink, cake and bread, and show the same faithfully one toward another, not only with empty words that come not from the heart, but in deeds and in truth, as John teacheth, without all guile, Amen.

The revision of 1553. The Württemberg order of 1553 revised the text, and nearly every later witness follows the revision. It moves the text back toward Brandenburg-Nürnberg in some places and adds Johannine clauses in others:

- **Dropped:** the Augustine clause ("forasmuch as the poor, weak consciences … may be comforted and strengthened"); "essential" and "own, essential and true" with the body and blood; "seal"; "severe" and "cruel"; "and kindly".
- **Restored from Brandenburg-Nürnberg:** "this holy Sacrament is given for a special comfort and strength to poor troubled consciences"; "for us and for our good"; "for our deliverance".
- **Added:**
  - "that feel their sins in the heart and confess them";
  - "for the wages of sin is death, as Paul saith" (Rom 6:23);
  - with the bread: "and that ye may always abide and live in me and I in you" (John 6:56);
  - with the cup: "and for the strength and furtherance of my life in you";
  - "and receiveth this Sacrament for the remembrance and confirmation of his faith", replacing "these word-signs which he receiveth of Christ";

    - "say to him everlasting praise and thanks therefor";
    - the closing doxology "The almighty, merciful God and Father of our dear Lord Jesus Christ help us thereto through his Holy Ghost, Amen".
- **Changed:** "paid" for "suffered"; "in the Supper" for "after the Supper"; "in deed and truth" for "by works and truth".
- **The editions of 1555 and after** (and Mömpelgard 1560, 1571) restore after "one bread and one body" the clause "forasmuch as we are all partakers of one bread and drink of one cup" (Sehling 16, p. 253, apparatus). All the later witnesses have it.

The witnesses.

Order	Sehling	Form and significant variants
Worms, *Agendbüchlein*, 1560	19/1, pp. 176–177	The **1536** text, but without the Augustine clause and without "essential"; "Ye dearly beloved in God"; "with right devotion" for "more fervently"; "troubled and grieved hearts"; ends at "are partakers of one bread and drink of one cup", without the grains and grapes, and goes straight to the open confession
Württemberg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1553	16, pp. 252–253	The revision
Kurpfalz, *Kirchenordnung*, 1556	14, pp. 148–149	1553 text; drops "faithfully" at the end
Leiningen-Westerburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1566	19/1, pp. 251–252	1553 text; "find nothing else"; "thank" for "give thanks"
Lindau, *Kirchenordnung*, 1573	12, p. 208	1553 text; "remember him"; "betrug" for "trug". Luther's paraphrase follows at the altar (§3.5.3).
Hanau-Lichtenberg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1573	20/2, pp. 64–65	1553 text; "for our sake" for "for our sins' sake"
Nassau-Weilburg, *Agende*, 1618	10, p. 275, apparatus	1553 text recast for the **communion of the sick**: "Dear friend in Christ, forasmuch as ye desire at this time to receive the gracious Supper … ye should rightly … examine … yourself"; the cross and love of neighbour in the second person ("Ye shall also take your cross upon you with patience")
Ysenburg-Ronneburg, *Agende*, 1582	10, pp. 579–580	1553 text, shortened at the end: after "not only with words but in deed and truth" it closes with "forasmuch as we are all partakers of one bread", without the grains and grapes
Strasbourg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1598	20/1, pp. 611–612	1553 text; drops "a drink floweth and mingleth together"
Isny, *Agende*, c. 1600	17/1, pp. 459–460	1553 text; a later hand notes "see the Ulm church order"
Solms-Laubach, *Kirchenzuchtordnung*, 1603	9, pp. 361–362	1553 text with scriptural glosses added: "as he himself saith in the sixth chapter of John"; "as Saint Paul saith, 1 Corinth. 10"; "his neighbour" for "one another"
Wild- und Rheingrafschaft, *Kirchenordnung*, 1603	19/2, pp. 618–619	1553 text, taken by way of Kurpfalz 1556 (editor's note)
Württemberg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1610	16, p. 620	Incipit only, followed by "the exhortation to public confession"

What the revision means. The 1553 reviser removed both the Augustinian language of signs and seals ("visible words", "word-signs", "seal") and the strongest realist word ("essential body"). In their place came the Johannine clauses of mutual indwelling and the Sacrament received "for the remembrance and confirmation of his faith". The orders that took the text over did not change it on either point.

3.5.7 The Bugenhagen family: Brunswick, 1528

The archetype. Bugenhagen's exhortation is read at the altar to the communicants, after the pulpit exhortation with its Creed, confession and general prayer (§3.4.4). **Brunswick, *Christlike ordeninge* of Johannes Bugenhagen, 1528** (Sehling 6/1, pp. 443–444):

Exhortation or admonition before the altar concerning the sacrament, to the communicants. My dearly beloved, it is continually set before us by the preaching of the Gospel of Christ that we of ourselves are ignorant, poor and lost sinners. And forasmuch as we of ourselves are no more than flesh and blood, therefore we can by no understanding or power of ours loose ourselves out of the strict judgment of God and from the power of the devil, wherein we are fallen through the transgression of the commandments and of the will of God. So God hath known our impotence better than we, and hath given for us, as a gracious Father, his only-begotten Son Jesus Christ, that we might be enlightened through his Gospel, and redeemed from our sins through his death, and through him be children of God, eternally saved, if we believed it. This he letteth be preached to us continually: whoso believeth it, he hath surely eternal life; upon such faith and unto such salvation are we also baptized; therein shall we abide continually; so abide we in Christ and Christ in us. So eat we continually without ceasing, spiritually with faith, the body of Christ and drink his blood; that is, we are incorporated into Christ, that we become one with him, in that we believe that he hath given his body into death for us and shed his blood for us on the cross; thereupon we rely for salvation against all false teaching, all sin, temptation and need. Out of which benefit of Christ we also learn what love and patience we shall exercise toward our neighbour, yea, toward our enemy. What would we more? Yet that we might not forget nor grow slack (as, alas, we do) in such faith in the incarnation and death of Christ, he hath also commanded us a special remembrance or showing forth of his death, as oft as we will, that we shall also in the outward sacrament, hidden from reason, known to faith alone out of the word of Christ, eat and drink his body and blood; that we may in no wise doubt that his death and shedding of blood on the cross is our sure salvation; thereof shall we sing, read, preach, hear, as we do in the Mass, and afterward also speak thereof and show it forth among one another, for our comfort and for the salvation of many, according to the command of Christ: This do in remembrance of me. Whoso now will worthily eat and drink this sacrament, he shall do two things: he shall believe what Christ saith, and do what he commandeth. He saith: This is my body, which is given for you. This is my blood, which is shed for you for the forgiveness of sins. That shall ye believe. But he commandeth: Take and eat. Drink ye all thereout, and remember me. That shall ye do according to his gracious word and command. Amen.

Note.

- **"two things"**, believing and doing, is the whole doctrine of worthy reception.
- **Two kinds of eating.** "so eat we continually … spiritually with faith" is the spiritual eating of John 6. The Sacrament is given in addition, "in the outward sacrament", so that we "may in no wise doubt".

The witnesses.

Order	Sehling	Form and significant variants
Hamburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1529	5, pp. 530–531	Low German, verbatim but for spelling
Lübeck, *Kirchenordnung*, 1531	5, p. 530, apparatus	As Hamburg (variants in the Hamburg apparatus)
Braunschweig-Wolfenbüttel, *Christlike kerken-ordeninge*, 1543	6/1, pp. 55–56	Low German; "through the transgression of the commandments" (dropping "and of the will of God"); "and also speak thereof among ourselves and to our children and household"; also offers Luther's paraphrase
Osnabrück, city and diocese, 1543	7/1, pp. 224, 258	Incipit only, "My dearly beloved etc.", read after the Sanctus
Frankfurt, *Agende* for baptism and the communion of the sick, 1543	9, pp. 517–518	A free High German paraphrase for the sick, "Ye most beloved in Christ our Lord! God causeth it to be preached to us continually through his holy word …"

Order	Sehling	Form and significant variants
Hildesheim, *Kirchenordnung*, 1544	7/2.1, p. 854	Incipit, with the editor's reference to Wolfenbüttel
Buxtehude, *Kirchenordnung*, 1552	7/1, p. 75	Incipit "My dearly beloved in Christ, by the preaching of the Gospel it is continually …"
Hadeln, *Kirchenordnung* "of 1526"	5, p. 468	Incipit only, "My dearly beloved etc.", read by the priest to the communicants after the sermon, before the Preface
Hamburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1556	5, p. 562	Incipit "My dearly beloved, it is continually set before us by the preaching of the Gospel etc."
Hildesheim (Steuerwald and Peine), *Kirchenordnung*, 1561	7/2.1, p. 782	Incipit, "Pomeranus's exhortation, set down in the Brunswick church order"
Lüneburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1564	6/1, pp. 547–548	**High German translation**, "Another exhortation" after the Osiander text (§3.5.4)
Braunschweig-Wolfenbüttel, *Kirchenordnung*, 1569	6/1, p. 147	High German, as Lüneburg
Lippe, *Kirchenordnung*, 1571	21, p. 413	High German, as Lüneburg, but skipping by homoeoteleuton from "judgement of God" to "so hath God"
Lippe, *Kirchenordnung*, 1571, communion of the sick	21, pp. 428–429	High German, ascribed to "D. Mart. Lutheri" (Dr. Martin Luther's); "of the holy Gospel … set forth"; drops "also toward our enemies"; "external" for "outward"
Verden, *Kirchenordnung*, 1606	7/1, p. 159	High German, as Lüneburg
Osnabrück (city), *Kirchenordnung*, 1613	7/1, p. 269	High German, **abridged and recast** (below)

The High German recension. Lüneburg 1564 translates the Low German text closely: "My dearly beloved, it is continually set before us by the preaching of the gospel of Christ, that we of ourselves are ignorant, poor sinners and lost …" (Sehling 6/1, p. 547). Braunschweig-Wolfenbüttel 1569, Lippe 1571 and Verden 1606 copy the Lüneburg translation, not the Low German.

Osnabrück 1613: the abridgement. The Osnabrück order of 1613 cuts the exhortation to half its length. It drops the passage on spiritual eating ("So eat we continually without ceasing, spiritually …") and replaces the account of sacramental eating with a statement of oral reception. **Osnabrück (city), *Kirchenordnung*, 1613** (Sehling 7/1, p. 269):

My dearly beloved, forasmuch as we of ourselves are nothing but flesh and blood, and cannot loose ourselves out of the strict judgment of God, into which we are fallen, God as a gracious Father hath given for us his only-begotten Son Jesus Christ, that through his death we might be redeemed from eternal death and so through him become children of God, eternally saved, if we believe on him. Upon such faith and unto such salvation are we baptized; thereof also is continually preached unto us. And that we may not forget nor grow slack in faith, love and patience, as, alas, we often do, he hath commanded a special remembrance and showing forth of his death: that in the outward sacrament, at Christ's command, we should eat with our bodily mouth, by means of the blessed bread, in a high mystery hidden from reason, the body of our Lord Jesus Christ, which he hath given into death for us, and drink out of the blessed cup his blood, which he hath shed for us; and should sing, read, preach and hear of his death and shedding of blood, according to the command of Christ: This do in remembrance of me.

The ending, "Whoso now will eat and drink this sacrament worthily, he shall do two things …", follows Bugenhagen's text. Sehling's editor: "It is in essence Bugenhagen's exhortation … but here it is more tightly summarized and shortened".

What the family shows. Bugenhagen's text was transmitted in two languages, but the High German form is a single translation, made once (Lüneburg 1564) and copied. Only Osnabrück 1613 rewrote its doctrine, replacing the spiritual eating of John 6 with the oral eating "with our bodily mouth by means of the blessed bread".

3.5.8 The Naumburg family, 1537

The archetype. The order for St. Wenzel's at Naumburg has a short exhortation of its own, read while the choir sings and the communicants gather in the choir, and followed by the German Sanctus. **Naumburg, *Kirchen-Ordnung* for St. Wenzel's, 1537** (Sehling 2, p. 80):

And while the whole choir thus singeth, the communicants shall gather in the choir, and then the priest shall make an exhortation to them, as followeth. Dear friends, forasmuch as ye are now gathered to keep and receive the testament of our dear Lord Jesus Christ, I admonish you that ye would take good heed of the precious gifts and graces which our dear Lord Jesus Christ hath bequeathed and given us herein, consider them with high diligence and give him thanks therefor; and that every one would examine himself herein, that he may worthily eat and drink of the bread and cup, which is the Lord's body and blood, so that he may know that this is given him by the Lord for the forgiveness of his sins and for the comfort and strength of his faith; and that thereafter he would go forth and, to the praise and thanks of Christ our dear Lord and God, serve his neighbour in true love and faithfulness according to all his power, even as Christ hath served us herewith, in that he hath redeemed us from eternal death by his holy, bitter passion and death, and made us children of eternal life. Upon this exhortation the whole choir singeth the Sanctus.

The witnesses.

Order	Sehling	Form and significant variants
Nördlingen, *Kirchenordnung* of Kaspar Löner, 1544	12, p. 312	Prescribes "a short exhortation" to the communicants, followed by the German Sanctus, as at Naumburg, but does not print it. The editor of Nördlingen 1579 takes it to be the Naumburg text, "brought to Nördlingen already by Löner".
Nördlingen, *Kirchenordnung*, 1579	12, pp. 369–370	Full (below)

Nördlingen 1579. The text is read "before the altar on which the Supper is distributed", after the Our Father. Sehling's editor: "Not from Württemberg 1553, where the Nürnberg exhortation is given, but from the Naumburg church order". Its changes:

- **The address** "Beloved in Christ Jesus!" for "Lieben freunde" (Dear friends).
- **"the Lord's body and blood"** in parentheses, and "that he may become worthy".
- **"redeemed from sins and eternal death"**.
- **A transition to the Verba**, sung in German after it: "But how Christ kept his Supper, and what he hath commanded us to believe and to do therein, ye shall further learn from the following words" (Sehling 12, p. 370).

3.5.9 The Mecklenburg family, 1552

The archetype. The Mecklenburg order makes the exhortation a short summary of repentance and faith, with a conditional, indicative absolution, a call to thanksgiving and intercession, and a long prayer in the first person singular for each communicant to make his own. It is read after the Preface and Sanctus, "if there is time". **Mecklenburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1552** (Sehling 5, pp. 202–204):

Exhortation: absolution, thanksgiving and prayer before the communion. Dear friends, ye that as Christian men have been instructed beforehand concerning God, concerning God's earnest will and law, concerning the creation of man's nature, and thereafter concerning our sin, and concerning the redemption through the Saviour Jesus Christ, and concerning all the articles of the faith, and truly believe the same, appear here and come to this high comfort which the Lord Christ giveth us in the eating of his body and blood. Now ye know the oath of the almighty, eternal God, wherein he saith: As I live, I will not the death of the sinner, but that he be converted and have life. This oath God hath confirmed with the blood, death and resurrection of his only-begotten Son Jesus Christ, and both are comprehended therein, conversion and forgiveness of sins. God hath sworn that it is his will that we shall not remain in sins against conscience, but shall turn to him, be terrified before his righteous wrath, and have hearty sorrow for our disobedience and our unthankfulness and dreadful contempt toward him. Whoso now bringeth such a heart (as God himself saith, he will dwell in the broken hearts and in them that fear his word), the same shall consider, desire and receive the great grace which is given us for the Lord Christ's sake, and shall firmly believe that all sins are forgiven them for the Lord Christ's sake, of grace, without our merit, if they receive this comfort with faith and trust in the Lord Christ; and shall not remain stuck in doubt, but truly conclude that they so receive forgiveness of sins, and are pleasing to God and heirs of eternal blessedness, and that the Lord Christ will surely give them his Holy Ghost, and that God will graciously dwell in them, govern and preserve them unto eternal blessedness; and they shall so henceforth be in obedience to him in faith and good conscience. All

this ye shall consider daily, and especially when ye come to the eating of the body and blood of our Lord Christ; there our Lord Christ putteth us in mind of both, namely that God's wrath against our sin is so great that he could not be reconciled otherwise than only by the obedience and death of his dearest Son, and also that he surely receiveth graciously all that are converted and trust in the Son. And for a sure witness of this his unchangeable will the Lord Christ hath instituted this ordinance, that with these outward visible things he surely giveth us his true body and blood, and confirmeth herewith his promise that our sins are surely forgiven us for the sake of his passion, and that he will truly be with us and work in us, as he saith: I am in them, and I give them eternal life. Therefore unto all that so appear here, that turn to God, and are terrified before God's wrath against their sin, and believe that their sins are forgiven them for the Lord Christ's sake, and have the purpose to leave off sins against conscience, unto them I declare forgiveness of sins, according to the words of Christ, Whose soever sins ye remit, they are remitted unto them; therefore by the command of the Lord Christ I speak unto you this absolution, that your sins are forgiven you for the Lord Christ's sake; and this voice of the Gospel ye shall receive, and have true comfort in the Lord Christ, and henceforth be obedient to God in faith and good conscience. And for a witness that this grace is given and applied to you yourselves, ye shall receive the body and the blood of the Lord Jesus Christ, and know that the Lord Christ hath been a sacrifice for you on the cross, and hath given his body for you and shed his blood for you, and that the Lord Christ maketh you his members and will be mighty in you. Here ye shall also give thanks to the almighty God, the Father of our Lord Jesus Christ, and to the Lord Jesus Christ, for such great graces, and have comfort and joy in the Lord Christ, for he will be with you, govern and preserve you; ye shall also here make your hearty prayer for the common Church and government, for yourselves and for your little children. Almighty, true God, eternal and only Father of our Saviour Jesus Christ, together with thine only Son Jesus Christ and the Holy Ghost, Creator of all creatures, who art wise, true, good, just, chaste and a judge, and art wroth against sin: I confess that I, alas, have much sin in me, and have moreover done much sin, knowingly and unknowingly, and it is heartily grievous unto me that I have angered thee, the true God; and I pray thee that thou wouldest forgive me all my sins through thy great mercy, for the sake of thy dearest Son Jesus Christ, be gracious unto me, and make me righteous and well-pleasing unto thee for the Lord Christ's sake and through him, and enlighten, cleanse and govern me with thy Holy Ghost. I believe also thy holy Gospel and thy gracious promise, wherein thou promisest us forgiveness of sins, righteousness and eternal life for the sake of thy dear Son Jesus Christ, and I pray thee that thou wouldest strengthen my heart in faith and in the knowledge of thy dear Son. I thank thee also, almighty God, for all benefits, and especially that thou hast graciously revealed thyself to us, and hast ordained thy dear Son to be mediator and propitiator for us, and through him hast rescued us from eternal wrath and received us again unto eternal blessedness. And I pray thee that for thy Son Jesus Christ's sake thou wouldest be gracious unto us poor, wretched, weak men, and gather unto thyself evermore among us an eternal Church, and preserve these lands and this government, and give us peace and blessed rule, and graciously govern and keep me and my poor little children, amen. I thank thee also, almighty only-begotten Son of God, Jesus Christ, that out of great love toward the poor human creature thou hast prayed for us, and hast taken human nature upon thee, that men might not be wholly cast away for ever, but through thee be rescued again from sins and brought to eternal righteousness and eternal life; and hast turned the great, unspeakable wrath of the divine majesty against our sins from us weak men upon thyself, in all thy obedience, passion and death, and art risen again from death, and abidest mediator and intercessor for us, and gatherest unto thyself an eternal Church through thy Gospel and Holy Ghost, and art Emmanuel, that is, God with us, givest eternal blessedness to all that are converted to thee and believe that God is gracious to them for the sake of thy passion and thy intercession, and wilt surely preserve these poor weak men in thy Church. I pray thee with hearty sighs that thou wouldest be gracious unto me, and forgive all my sins, and pray thine eternal Father for me, and give me thy Holy Ghost, govern and preserve me against thine enemies, namely against the blasphemous, lying, unclean devils. And mayest thou, almighty Son of God, Jesus Christ, who didst die on the cross and on the third day didst rise again alive, and art just, true, chaste and merciful, gather unto thyself evermore among us an eternal Church, and preserve this land and this government, and give us peace and blessed rule, and graciously govern and keep me and my poor little children, amen.

The witnesses.

Order	Sehling	Form and significant variants
Pfalz-Zweibrücken, *Kirchenordnung*, 1557	18, pp. 189–190	Verbatim, under the same heading. The Zweibrücken hymnal of 1571/1587 prints the section for the people and introduces the prayer with "if one can have it in the time, one may also add the following prayer".
Nassau-Weilburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1576	10, pp. 264–266	Verbatim in 1576; replaced in the *Agende* of 1618 (below)
Sayn, *Kirchenordnung*, 1590	19/1, pp. 406–408	Taken from Pfalz-Zweibrücken (editor's note); a second "Christian" added to "Christian men"; ends after the call to thanksgiving, with the rubric for the Our

Order	Sehling	Form and significant variants
		Father and Verba in place of the prayer
Pfalz-Veldenz, *Kirchenordnung*, 1574	18, p. 501	The prayer only, turned into the first person plural ("We confess indeed, Lord, that we have many sins upon us, are by nature sinful and unclean …"), after Pfalz-Veldenz's own exhortation (§3.5.11)

Nassau-Weilburg 1618: the abridged recension. The Nassau-Weilburg *Agende* of 1618 replaces the text with a shorter form. It is addressed to those "who announced yourselves yesterday", recalls "the exhortation made to you yesterday", and keeps the conditional absolution. It then adds a passage on the Words of Institution and ends with the *Sursum corda* (Lift up your hearts). **Nassau-Weilburg, *Agende*, 1618, from Sehling's apparatus to the order of 1576** (Sehling 10, p. 264):

That ye lay hold of these words with right, true faith and doubt not, but firmly believe: as surely as the Son of God, according to his own promise, feedeth you in the Supper and giveth you to drink with his own body and blood, so surely and truly doth he also deliver to you and to every one in particular all the spiritual benefits which he hath merited and obtained for his dear Christendom by the offering of his body and the shedding of his precious blood, such as forgiveness of sins, the righteousness that availeth before God, and after this life the eternal, blessed life. Lastly ye shall also here make your prayer to God for the need of all Christendom, for your dear government, for yourselves and for your little children. Lift up therefore your hearts unto God, our Lord, for it is meet and right, and also wholesome, that we should in all places and at all times call upon our heavenly Father and holy God through Jesus Christ, our Saviour.

3.5.10 The Palatinate family, 1563

The archetype. The Reformed Palatinate order of Elector Frederick III (1563) has the longest exhortation in the corpus. It is read "at the table" after the sermon and the Sunday prayer. It follows Geneva 1563 (Reformed) almost word for word at the beginning, and draws on London 1565 (à Lasco and Micron, Reformed) for the threefold examination and the fencing of the table, and on Kurpfalz 1556 (the Württemberg text) for the grains and grapes. **Palatinate, *Kirchenordnung*, 1563** (Reformed; Sehling 14, pp. 383–386):

Ye beloved in the Lord Jesus Christ, hear the words of the institution of the holy Supper of our Lord Jesus Christ, which the holy apostle Paul describeth to us in the first epistle to the Corinthians, in the eleventh chapter [1 Corinthians 11:23–29]: I have received of the Lord that which I delivered unto you. For the Lord Jesus, in the night in which he was betrayed, took bread, gave thanks, brake it and said: Take, eat, this is my body, which is broken for you. This do in remembrance of me. After the same manner also the cup after the supper, and said: This cup is the new testament in my blood. This do, as oft as ye drink it, in remembrance of me. For as often as ye eat this bread and drink this cup, ye shall show the Lord's death till he come. Whosoever now shall eat this bread unworthily or drink of the cup of the Lord, he is guilty of the body and blood of the Lord. But let a man examine himself, and so let him eat of this bread and drink of this cup. For he that eateth and drinketh unworthily eateth and drinketh judgment to himself, in that he discerneth not the Lord's body. That we may now keep the Lord's Supper to our comfort, it is needful for us above all things, first, that we rightly examine ourselves beforehand; secondly, that we direct it to that end for which the Lord Christ ordained it, namely to his remembrance. The true examination of ourselves standeth in these three parts. First, let every one consider by himself his sin and curse, that he may be displeased with himself and humble himself before God, forasmuch as the wrath of God against sin is so great that, rather than let it go unpunished, he hath punished it in his dear Son Jesus Christ with the bitter and shameful death of the cross. Secondly, let every one search his heart whether he also believe this sure promise of God, that all his sins are forgiven him only for the sake of the passion and death of Jesus Christ, and that the perfect righteousness of Christ is imputed and given him as his own, as if he himself in his own person had paid for all his sins and fulfilled all righteousness. Thirdly, let every one search his conscience whether he be also minded henceforth to show himself thankful to God the Lord with his whole life and to walk uprightly before the face of God; whether he also renounce from the heart, without all hypocrisy, all enmity, envy and hatred, and have an earnest purpose hereafter to live in true love and unity with his neighbour. They now that are so minded, them God will surely receive into grace and acknowledge for worthy table-companions of his Son Jesus Christ. But on the other hand, they that feel not this witness in their heart eat and drink judgment to themselves. Therefore we also, according to the command of Christ and of the apostle Paul, warn away from the table of the Lord all that know themselves laden with the following vices, and declare unto them that they have no part in the kingdom of Christ: as are all idolaters; all that call upon departed saints, angels or other creatures, that worship images; all sorcerers and soothsayers, that bless cattle and people and other things, and they that give credence to such blessing; all despisers of God and of his word and of the holy sacraments; all blasphemers; all that seek to make division and mutiny in the

Church and in the temporal government; all perjurers; all that are disobedient to their parents and rulers; all manslayers, brawlers, quarrellers, that live in envy and hatred against their neighbour; all adulterers, whoremongers, drunkards, thieves, usurers, robbers, gamblers, covetous, and all they that lead an offensive life. All these, so long as they persevere in such vices, shall take heed and abstain from this meat, which Christ hath ordained for his faithful alone, lest their judgment and damnation be the heavier. But this is not set before us, dear Christians, to make the broken hearts of the faithful faint-hearted, as though none might go to the Supper of the Lord but they that were without all sin. For we come not to this Supper to bear witness thereby that we are perfect and righteous in ourselves, but on the contrary, because we seek our life outside ourselves in Jesus Christ, we confess that we lie in the midst of death. Therefore, although we yet find much infirmity and misery in us, as namely that we have not a perfect faith, that we do not give ourselves to serve God with such zeal as we are bound to do, but have daily to strive with the weakness of our faith and the evil lusts of our flesh; nevertheless, since by the grace of the Holy Ghost such infirmities are grievous to us from the heart, and we heartily desire to resist our unbelief and to live according to all the commandments of God, we shall be sure and certain that no sin nor infirmity which yet remaineth in us against our will can hinder God from receiving us into grace and so making us worthy partakers of this heavenly meat and drink. Secondly, let us now also consider to what end the Lord hath instituted his Supper for us, namely that we do it in remembrance of him. And we shall remember him herein thus: first, that we wholly trust in our heart that our Lord Jesus Christ, according to the promises which were made to the patriarchs from the beginning, was sent by the Father into this world, took our flesh and blood upon him, bore for us the wrath of God, under which we should have sunk for ever, from the beginning of his incarnation to the end of his life on earth, and fulfilled for us all obedience to the divine law and righteousness; chiefly when the burden of our sins and of the wrath of God pressed out from him the bloody sweat in the garden; when he was bound, that he might loose us; then suffered countless reproach, that we might never be put to shame; was condemned to death innocent, that we might be acquitted before the judgment seat of God; yea, let his blessed body be nailed to the cross, that he might nail thereto the handwriting of our sins, and so took the curse upon himself from us, that he might fill us with his blessing; and humbled himself to the very deepest shame and hellish anguish of body and soul on the tree of the cross, when he cried with a loud voice: My God, my God, why hast thou forsaken me [Matthew 27:46], that we might be taken to God and never be forsaken of him; and finally by his death and shedding of blood sealed the new and everlasting testament, the covenant of grace and reconciliation, as he said: It is finished [John 19:30]. But that we might firmly believe that we belong to this covenant of grace, the Lord Jesus in his last Supper took the bread, gave thanks, brake it, gave it to his disciples and said: Take and eat, this is my body, which is given for you; this do in remembrance of me. Likewise after the supper he took the cup, gave thanks and said: Take and drink ye all of it; this cup is the new testament in my blood, which is shed for you and for many for the forgiveness of sins. This do, as oft as ye drink it, in remembrance of me. That is, as oft as ye eat of this bread and drink of this cup, ye shall thereby, as by a sure memorial and pledge, be reminded and assured of this my hearty love and faithfulness toward you: that for you, who must otherwise have died the eternal death, I give my body unto death on the tree of the cross and shed my blood, and feed and give drink to your hungry and thirsty souls with the same my crucified body and shed blood unto eternal life, as surely as this bread is broken before the eyes of every one and this cup is given him, and ye eat and drink them with your mouth in remembrance of me. From this institution of the holy Supper of our Lord Jesus Christ we see that he directeth our faith and trust to his perfect sacrifice, once made on the cross, as to the only ground and foundation of our salvation, in that he is become the true meat and drink of eternal life to our hungry and thirsty souls. For by his death he hath taken away the cause of our eternal hunger and misery, namely sin, and hath obtained for us the quickening Spirit, that through the same Spirit, which dwelleth in Christ as the head and in us as his members, we might have true fellowship with him and become partakers of all his goods, of eternal life, righteousness and glory. Moreover, that through the same Spirit we might also be bound together one with another, as members of one body, in true brotherly love, as the holy apostle saith: It is one bread, so are we, being many, one body, forasmuch as we are all partakers of one bread [1 Corinthians 10:17]. For as out of many grains one meal is ground and one bread baked, and out of many grapes pressed together one wine and drink floweth and is mingled together, so shall we all, that are incorporated into Christ by true faith, through brotherly love, for the sake of Christ our dear Saviour, who first loved us so highly, be all together one body, and show the same one toward another not only with words but in deed. The almighty, merciful God and Father of our Lord Jesus Christ help us thereto through his Holy Ghost, Amen.

What follows. A prayer for the right use of the Supper ("Merciful God and Father, we pray thee that in this Supper … thou wouldest work in our hearts through thy Holy Ghost …"), the Our Father and the Apostles' Creed, and then the call to lift up the heart: "let us not cleave with our hearts to the outward bread and wine, but lift up our hearts and faith on high into heaven, where Christ Jesus is" (Sehling 14, p. 386). It is the Reformed form of the *Sursum corda*.

The witnesses.

Order	Sehling	Form and significant variants
Moers, *Kirchenordnung*, 1581 (Reformed)	22, pp. 197–199	Lower Rhine recension (below); the manuscript is supplemented by the editor from the Palatinate print where it has gaps
Bentheim-Tecklenburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1588/1619 (Reformed)	22, pp. 271–274	Lower Rhine recension; drops "and those that put faith in such charms" from the list of the excluded
Ysenburg-Birstein, *Kirchenordnung*, 1598 (Reformed)	10, pp. 651–653	Verbatim; the editor: the whole chapter, prayers included, "comes word for word from the Palatinate order of 1563"
Palatinate, *Kirchenordnung*, 1585 (later edition) (Reformed)	14, p. 384, apparatus	Allows the passage marked off in the margin to be left out "as the cold of winter or other need requireth"

The Lower Rhine recension. Moers and Bentheim (both Reformed) share a set of changes:

- **A new transition after the Pauline text**, which recalls the opening of Micron's exhortation (Reformed) ("Ye have heard, dear brethren, from this doctrine of the holy apostle Paul, who is the institutor of the Supper …", Sehling 7/1, p. 631). **Moers, *Kirchenordnung*, 1581** (Reformed; Sehling 22, p. 197):

From this teaching of the holy apostle Paul ye hear, dear Christians, that our Lord and Saviour Jesus Christ instituted and kept the holy Supper with his disciples, and that he hath commanded us so to keep the same.

- **The first point of the examination expanded:** "his sin which he hath done against God and his holy law and against his neighbour, and then the curse and righteous wrath of God against sin".
- **The second point:** "all his sins, original as well as actual", forgiven "of grace".
- **The third point:** thankfulness "for his unspeakable grace and mercy, and especially for the gracious forgiveness of all our sins", "all the time of his life"; "all enmity, hatred, envy".
- **The excluded:** those that persevere in the vices "and purpose to continue therein".
- **The Spirit:** "hath obtained for us the quickening Spirit by his intercession" for "merited".
- **Moers** reads "grape-berries" for "berries".

3.5.11 The Pfalz-Veldenz family, 1574

The archetype. The Pfalz-Veldenz order has an exhortation of its own, read by the pastor after the Sanctus ("Esaja, dem Propheten, das geschach") and before the communion. It closes with a call to confession and prayer that leads into the Mecklenburg prayer, turned into the plural (§3.5.9). **Pfalz-Veldenz, *Kirchenordnung*, 1574** (Sehling 18, pp. 500–501):

Ye beloved in the Lord Christ. It is well known to you as Christians, out of God's word and daily experience, that we were all together conceived and born in sins, and also still sin daily and continually and transgress God's commandments, and that we are thereby subject to the heavy wrath of God and to eternal damnation. Now out of so great a need we could be helped in no other way than only by the bitter and most holy death and joyful resurrection of our Lord and Saviour Jesus Christ, the eternal and only Son of God. He out of immeasurable love and compassion hath laden the heavy burden of our sins upon himself, fastened it to the cross and buried it in the earth, and so by the shedding of his precious, innocent blood hath paid for sin and redeemed mankind from sins and eternal damnation. This his precious merit, and all that he hath obtained and gained thereby, he giveth and bestoweth on us poor sinners freely, out of pure grace and mercy; we are not worthy of it, neither can we merit it nor add anything thereto; only we should heartily take it to ourselves, rejoice and comfort ourselves with firm faith and whole trust. Whoso doeth that, he enjoyeth and is made partaker of the merit of Christ, is set free from sins and death, and is an heir of eternal life. But forasmuch as it is very hard for human nature, especially when a man knoweth not and feeleth not his sin, truly to believe this, that the only-begotten Son of God suffered such a shameful, bitter death for us poor sinners, and that the heavenly Father will forgive us all sins and give us eternal life only for his sake, out of pure grace and mercy, therefore our faithful Saviour Christ Jesus hath not only richly promised and pledged us such great grace in his holy word, but also confirmed and sealed it with outward, visible signs, and especially instituted for this end this holy Sacrament of his body and blood, that thereby our weak faith may be strengthened, our fainthearted consciences comforted, and wholly assured of his promised grace. Since he himself is here present, and in the eating of these outward, visible things, bread and wine, giveth us his true body and blood for meat and drink, as sure pledges and seals, to assure us thereby that he hath as surely and truly given his holy body for

us and shed his innocent blood for our sins, and that our sins are surely forgiven us for the sake of his passion and death; that he also will be with us, dwell and work in us, and as living members of his body at last raise us from death and give us eternal life. Such glorious, sweet comfort have we in this his holy Supper. Therefore, as oft as we feel that we are weak and fainthearted in faith, sinful and frail in life, we shall betake ourselves to this comfortable, heavenly table and Supper, that we may be made sure of our reconciliation with God and of the forgiveness of our sins through the death of Christ, and so be strengthened and comforted in faith in the Lord Christ. But that we may use and enjoy this Sacrament rightly and worthily, to our comfort and the salvation of our souls, we must first examine ourselves according to the teaching of the holy apostle Paul: and first acknowledge and confess our sins before God with hearty pain, repentance and sorrow; then secondly firmly believe that our sins are forgiven us only of pure grace for the Lord Jesus Christ's sake; and lastly have a true purpose to forsake sins, to amend our life with God's help, and henceforth to walk in Christian love. For our Lord God will not the death and destruction of the sinner; but therewith he requireth also true conversion, as is declared in the precious oath which he hath sworn by the prophet: As I live (saith God), I will not that the sinner die, but that he be converted and have life. Therefore, my beloved, forasmuch as our dear Lord God hath pleasure in sinners that humble themselves before him and turn to him, and the Lord Christ also inviteth and biddeth to this his meal such guests as hunger and thirst after righteousness, let us also lift up our hearts to God with earnestness, heartily lament and confess to him our misery and our frail and sinful life, and in the name of his dearest Son, our only Redeemer Jesus Christ, pray for the pardon of all our sins and misdeeds; heartily thank him also for his glorious graces and benefits which he hath shown to us and to all Christendom in the same his beloved Son Jesus Christ; and then further pray for the strengthening of faith, the amendment of our sinful life, and all other need of all Christendom. Say therefore with me from your whole heart:

What follows. "confession and common prayer at the communion": the Mecklenburg prayer in the plural, "Almighty, merciful God, eternal and only Father of our Lord Jesus Christ … We confess indeed, Lord, that we have many sins upon us, are by nature sinful and unclean …" (Sehling 18, p. 501). The exhortation itself draws on Mecklenburg 1552 for the oath of Ezekiel 33:11 and the call to conversion.

The witness. Lützelstein, *Kirchenordnung*, 1605 (Sehling 18, pp. 603–604) copies the text; the editor marks the section "from the Pfalz-Veldenz church order". It drops "truly to believe", "richly promised" and "and biddeth", and ends "say therefore humbly with me".

3.5.12 The Basel family: Memmingen 1528 and Neckarbischofsheim 1560

The archetype. The Memmingen order of 1528 (Moderate Reformed) has an exhortation read *after* communion. Sehling's editor notes that it is not in the Zürich order, which Memmingen otherwise follows. Neckarbischofsheim 1560 has the same text, which its editor traces to Oecolampadius's Basel order, *Form und gstalt* (Form and manner; Basel 1526, Reformed). **Memmingen, *Kirchenordnung*, 1528** (Moderate Reformed; Sehling 12, p. 245):

After the eating, when every one hath eaten and drunk, followeth the exhortation hereafter following. Dear brethren! Ye have heard the unspeakable mercy of God. The heavenly Father hath given his only-begotten Son for us into the most shameful death. The shepherd hath died for the sheep. The innocent hath suffered for the sinner, the head for the members. The high priest hath offered himself up for us to the Father as a burning sacrifice, out of unspeakable love, and with his blood hath sufficiently assured and sealed our covenant with God the Father. Therefore let us keep the benefits in everlasting, fresh remembrance! His blood touch our heart! To him be praise for evermore! Now henceforth we will not be our own, but the Lord's servants and the servants of his servants. Now we will live to Christ and not to ourselves, and desire so to be incorporated into him as the members that are redeemed by his blood and cleansed from sins.

What follows at Memmingen. The deacons say Ps 113 in alternation ("Praise the Lord, ye servants!"), and the leader then gives the second exhortation, which comes from Strasbourg (Moderate Reformed; §3.5.13), ending with the Ten Commandments and the dismissal "Now go in the peace of God".

The witness. Neckarbischofsheim, *Kirchenordnung*, 1560 (Sehling 16, pp. 682–683). Its form:

- **Placement.** The pastor reads it at the altar *before* communion, as "the communicants' exhortation or reminder of the passion and death of Jesus Christ, with an appended exhortation".
- **The opening.** Before it stands Isaiah 53, introduced: "Beloved friends and chosen children of God, forasmuch as in the receiving of the holy Supper the chief point and the whole matter is to consider with hearty thanksgiving his bitter passion and death, hear and consider how the holy prophet Isaiah foresaw it in the spirit long ago".

- **The common text** follows with "Here ye hear openly, beloved children of God" for "Ye have heard"; "His blood sprinkle and touch our hearts" (Heb 10:22); "To him be praise, honour and glory for ever"; "thereto servant and minister of his servants".
- **An addition on the Supper**, leading to the Words of Institution. **Neckarbischofsheim, *Kirchenordnung*, 1560** (Sehling 16, p. 683):

Wherefore we also are mindful with thanksgiving of the benefits of his body and blood, which he truly giveth us to enjoy in the power of faith in his word, figured in the bodily meat and drink of the hallowed bread and wine of his Supper, which he himself instituted and ordained us to keep in remembrance of his bitter passion and death.

3.5.13 The Strasbourg family, 1525

The archetype. The early Strasbourg agendas (Moderate Reformed) leave the exhortation to the pastor, "on the content of the prayer and generally according to the matter of the sermon preached", and print one as an example. It was given at St. Peter the Younger, Wolfgang Capito's church, on Reminiscere Sunday, 12 March 1525, after a sermon on 1 Cor 1 (the word of the cross) and John 8 (Christ the light of the world). It is read after the Our Father and leads into the Words of Institution. **Strasbourg, *Die frühen Agenden*, 1525** (Moderate Reformed; Sehling 20/1, pp. 158–159):

Dear brothers and sisters, ye will every one consider with himself with what hearty desire the Lord Jesus did his suffering for us, and how great longing he had to eat the passover lamb with his disciples before he suffered; and how he commanded that this his remembrance should be had as oft as his Supper is kept, as the old Christians nearly did in their assemblies, and as we in some measure show on the Sunday, in that some of you eat with me. And yet I hope that ye all consider it in firm faith, and eat as fruitfully in the spirit as they that come forward; for the outward eating would bring us much disorder and trouble if every one would also eat bodily every time; for in all things we should not practise the outward deeds of the Lord, but the chief part inwardly, which here is the remembrance of our redemption, which may well be with all of you that stand about. Therefore I exhort you that ye let yourselves be taken by the word of the cross, which to you that are saved is the power of God, as to the damned world it is foolishness and to the pious hypocrites an offence. Receive Christ, the light of the world, and walk no more henceforth in darkness, that is, after the manner of flesh and blood, which is full of strife, quarrelling and discord. For if ye take upon you, and by your eating or presence falsely pretend, faith in Christ and love toward your neighbour, and yet stood in grudge against your brethren, know that ye lie to God the Holy Ghost, that ye are hypocrites, and that ye are at the Lord's Supper unworthily, or eat to yourselves judgment and damnation. Let us pray God, therefore, that he would uncover to us the hidden Adam in us, and show his salvation, which he hath wrought through Christ Jesus.

Note. The exhortation assumes that only some will commune ("In that some of you eat with me"), and that the rest "eat in the spirit". It then turns to the invitation: "Ye that will receive the Lord's Supper with me, and have announced yourselves, come now hither" (Sehling 20/1, p. 159).

The witness. Memmingen 1528 (Moderate Reformed) takes the second half, from "that ye let the word of the cross lay hold upon you", as the exhortation of the leader after Ps 113 and after communion (Sehling 12, pp. 245–246). It reads "after the manner of the evil, poisoned nature of blood and flesh", turns the warning into the past ("would have received the Lord's Supper unworthily"), and ends with a prayer that God lead us "out of ourselves and all creatures to his only-begotten Son", followed by the Ten Commandments.

3.5.14 Exhortations outside the families

The exhortations below belong to none of the families in §3.5.3–3.5.13. Four are printed in full; the rest are summarized.

3.5.14.1 Kantz 1522 and the Bremen Mass 1525

Kantz's Nördlingen Mass of 1522 leaves the exhortation free: "an exhortation of the Sacrament, or else something comforting out of the holy Gospel, as the Spirit of God giveth him". It then gives only a short address to the bystanders, "Dearest in Christ! That ye may receive with joyful, desirous heart …", which leads at once into the absolution. That address and absolution are printed in Chapter 7 §7.2.1, and summarized in §3.3.5 here.

The Low German *Evangelische Misse* (Evangelical Mass) printed at Bremen in 1525 has the same rubric and a translation of the same address. **Bremen, *Eyne evangelysce Misse*, 1525** (Sehling 7/2.2, p. 405):

First shall the priest, or another chosen thereto, make an exhortation of the Sacrament, or else somewhat comforting out of the holy Gospel, and say what the Spirit of God giveth him. Therefore shall he exhort the bystanders with these or the like words: Dearest in Christ, that ye may receive with joyful and desirous hearts the precious treasure and the testament of the flesh and blood of Christ Jesus, our Saviour, humble your hearts before God and confess to him your sins and failings with hearty desire, striving after his godly grace and help. So will I now read you the absolution.

The differences. Bremen has "the precious treasure and the testament of the flesh and blood" for Kantz's "the tender body and rose-coloured blood". It drops "your chosen priest", and it heads the priest's request for prayer "the priest's confession". The absolution keeps Kantz's indicative form (§3.4.4).

3.5.14.2 Augsburg, St. Anna, 1530

The order of the Supper (Moderate Reformed) "as it was kept by the ministers of the Gospel at St. Anna's" prints two exhortations. The first, the longer, is a sermon on 1 Cor 11:28 in three heads: why Christ died, the love of God in his death, and the example of love it leaves. **Augsburg, *Form und ordnung des Herren nachtmal*, 1530** (Moderate Reformed; Sehling 12, pp. 40–41):

Beloved! St. Paul exhorteth us, 1 Cor 11[:28], that we should first prove ourselves and then go to God's table. Therefore shall your love first see wherein the proof standeth, that none eat and drink the judgment. So must we now consider with earnestness what is done here, what is here, and what shall be sought here. One shall first look at what Christ hath done and commanded us to do, namely: we shall remember him and show forth his saving death till he come. Here is no belly-meal, but a meat and drink unto a new life, wherein Christ will feed us with his true body and give us to drink of his true blood, which are present here for his word's sake, as he fed his disciples and gave them to drink in the first Supper; through which body and his blood he hath bought us on the cross by his death from eternal death, purchased remission of sin, and set up and confirmed the covenant of grace between God the Father and us, that through Christ and in Christ we should become children of God, and God be our Father. Therefore we seek here no earthly, perishable things, but eternal. We are sick and seek the medicine of life. We are hungry and thirsty and seek the living bread that cometh from heaven: Jesus Christ, the well of eternal life. Whoso trusteth in him shall be satisfied and have eternal life. That trust is, that we shall not doubt that the Son of God, Jesus Christ, of the gracious will of his and our heavenly Father, hath died for us poor sinners and hath reconciled us again to the heavenly Father. That is the right Christian faith. Whoso looketh not for such from Christ, namely, that he is our Saviour, who will and can help us out of all evil (for he is true God, and for our sakes is made man), he were an unbeliever and eateth judgment to himself. Therefore we shall see that here not the bodily but the spiritual hunger and thirst is to be stilled. So Christ now commandeth us that we shall keep the Supper in remembrance of him, and Paul saith that we shall show forth the Lord's death till he come. Here must we now take three things before us: first, to see the cause why Christ died; secondly, to take to heart the love and grace of God in the death of his only-begotten Son; thirdly, to consider how Christ hath not only redeemed us by his death, but also left an example, whereby we learn what faithfulness and love every Christian oweth to his fellow man. If we can now rightly call ourselves to mind in these three points, and find ourselves ready thereto, or at the least desirous, that we would gladly walk in faith and love, then the proof standeth whereof St. Paul speaketh [1 Cor 11:28].

First, mark that Christ died for our sins' sake. It must verily be no small cause, that God's Son should himself come from heaven into this world and give himself into the despised death of the cross. Hereby we mark the greatness and heaviness of our sin, which might not be atoned unless such an infinite person took it upon himself, Isaiah 53[:4f.]. How terrible is the judgment of God upon sin and sinners! How murderous is the harm of our sin, that the only-begotten, dearest Son of God should become a curse and die, that we might be redeemed from the eternal curse and death! Since then Christ himself dieth, that he may make satisfaction for us and reconcile the Father again, and purchase the Spirit of God, whereby we are enlightened, cleansed and made ready to be children of God, verily we should form in our heart the precious death of Christ, this unmeasurable cost, and hate and flee the damned sin, which was a cause of death to Christ, as hellish poison and death, and set ourselves to a penitent life. Here let every one go into himself, whether he repent that he hath so often and so manifoldly sinned against God, wherefore he is worthy of eternal damnation, and whether he desire by God's grace to be rid of sins and to lead a Christian life! If not, he standeth ill.

Secondly, consider the great grace and love of God, who spared not his only-begotten Son, but gave him into death for us. So loved he the world, that he sent his only-begotten into the world, that whosoever believeth in him should not perish, but have eternal life. Where hath such love ever been heard of? While we were yet sinners, Christ died for us; while we were yet enemies, we are reconciled to God by the death of his Son, Romans 5[:10]. If your great sin and the righteous judgment of God have

before terrified you, as is meet, so be comforted again! Our sins lie no more upon us, if we believe, but upon the unspotted lamb of God. He hath atoned them, abolished death, brought life again; and Christ is given us of the Father, that he may be our wisdom, righteousness, sanctification and redemption. Of this we all have good need, since we in ourselves were fools, unrighteous, unholy, poor, captive sinners of the evil enemy. Such great things belong to us and become our own, if we doubt not of the love of God, that he hath given us his Son Jesus Christ, that we may live through him. Not that we loved him before; but he loved us first, and so sent his Son to be a reconciler for our sin, 1 John 4[:9]. There ye hear such things in the Supper, how Christ hath given his body and blood for us. If we believe these words, we overcome sin, death, hell, receive peace, joy and assurance of conscience, so that we become thankful, to do and to suffer willingly for such goodness what Christ layeth upon us. For this sacrament is also called *eucharistia*, that we thereby should praise and extol God's mercy and give thanks for his unspeakable love. Where we always remember his death, and therein his fatherly faithfulness, we become humble and thankful, grow in trust toward God through Christ, become heedful, and order ourselves to a new life, which then shall and must be, or we shall be called titular Christians only.

Thirdly, the Supper putteth us in mind of Christian love and unity; for if Christ hath died for us, it is a token that we have fellowship in his passion and death; and as the head hath suffered death for his members and laid the highest love upon them, we also shall not despise one another; for we are children of God through the merit of Christ, among whom such great goods are dealt out; and this love of Christ shall be an example to us, that we be so minded one toward another as Christ toward us, namely, that one serve another with all that he is and hath, as in the natural body one member serveth another. Ill will, backbiting, hatred and all other vices must be put away; for what wouldest thou do at the common Supper of the Lord, if thy neighbour were not well commended to thee, for whom Christ hath died, and who shall enjoy all his goods with all the elect? Thou showest thyself outwardly as a fellow member, who acknowledgeth Christ for his redeemer and the others for his fellow heirs and brethren, and yet thou despisest thy neighbour and grudgest him all good. If thou wilt be no member of the body of Christ, in that thou mayest not suffer the other fellow members, love them and serve them, take their need upon thee as were it thine own, then thou hatest also the head, Christ, and belongest therefore not in this fellowship.

Therefore look to yourselves! It is no child's play to go to the Lord's Supper. Rude, insolent, heedless folk, to whom it is nothing whether they sin or not, let them stay away. But spiritually poor folk, that have a burdened conscience and would fain be godly, although they be yet very imperfect, yet if they have a displeasure at their own sin, they shall come and receive the body and blood of Jesus Christ in the Supper; for God is gracious to the humble.

The second exhortation. After the Words of Institution the order gives a shorter text, "used at the late Diet [of 1530] for brevity's sake, and afterwards commonly on Sunday, together with other Christian exhortations out of divine scripture". It contains an indicative general absolution. **Augsburg, *Form und ordnung des Herren nachtmal*, 1530** (Moderate Reformed; Sehling 12, p. 42):

Beloved! Ye know that we have commandment from Christ, our Lord and God, that we should so preach and minister the holy sacraments, preach forgiveness of sins and forgive all sins in the stead of God and of our Lord Christ, to all them that desire such and believe it; for thus it is written [John 20:23]: Whose sins ye remit, they shall be remitted unto them, and whose ye retain, they shall be retained. Therefore will I first proclaim to you forgiveness of sins in the stead and on the behalf of God and of our Lord Christ, as Christ our Lord hath made satisfaction for all our sins by his death, and reconciled God, and purchased grace without our merit, and commanded that for his sake such be preached in all the world, and sins be rebuked and forgiven. Therefore I pronounce you all, and each one in particular that desireth it, free from your sins, and they shall be forgiven you of grace for Christ's sake, by divine commandment, in the name of God the Father and of the Son and of the Holy Ghost. The peace of God be with you! Amen.

And ye shall also believe this absolution as God's word and commandment, no less than if ye heard God's voice sound from heaven; and know that ye receive grace and forgiveness of sins through this faith alone, and that this faith is the highest and right Christian service of God, that ye give God the honour of holding him true, that he will keep his promise, will be gracious, as he hath promised, will also hear and help, if ye seek help of him; and ye shall exercise such faith in all need, that ye may learn by experience that God is wont truly to show grace and help to them that call upon him and in him, and that this faith may ever increase, so that one hope all good of God and seek it of him. For this also is the holy sacrament instituted, to remember that our Lord Christ died for us for sin's sake and rose again, that he might give us grace, the Holy Ghost and eternal life. Therefore ye shall so receive the holy sacrament that ye truly believe that grace and forgiveness of sins is offered you herein; for Christ our Lord giveth us his body and his blood, that we may indeed believe and truly hold that he will be with us and impart to us his life, his Holy Ghost and his goods. Amen.

Notes.

- **The absolution.** "Therefore I declare you all, and each one in particular that desireth it, free of your sins" is indicative, like Kantz's, and grounded in John 20:23. It belongs with the forms in §3.4.4.
- **The order of parts.** The first exhortation stands before communion; the minister then rehearses the Words of Institution ("before the minister communicates the congregation with the Gospel, he repeats the words of the Supper").
- **Other exhortations.** Sehling's editor, citing Fille (1895), notes that "some other such exhortations also, mostly by Urban Rhegius" were once kept: "but they are now lost" (Sehling 12, p. 40).

3.5.14.3 Buxtehude, *Agende*, 1565

The Buxtehude *Agende* prints, after the Latin Prefaces, a "exhortation before the receiving of the Sacrament". It builds on the Words of Institution, which it rehearses in full, and draws four lessons from them: what the Sacrament is, who instituted it, what it is for, and who receive it to salvation. It ends with a prayer said by all. **Buxtehude, *Agende*, 1565** (Sehling 7/1, pp. 124–125):

My dear Christians, all that will consider and keep this holy Supper of our Lord Jesus Christ fruitfully to their salvation, it is highly needful that before all things they know firmly the words of the institution of this Supper, as the holy evangelists and Paul have written them, which run thus: Our Lord Jesus Christ, in the night in which he was betrayed, took the bread, gave thanks, and brake it, and gave it to his disciples, and said: Take, eat; this is my body, which is given for you; this do in remembrance of me. After the same manner also he took the cup after supper, gave thanks, gave it them, and said: Drink ye all of it; this cup is the new testament in my blood, which is shed for you for the remission of sins; this do, as oft as ye drink it, in remembrance of me.

Whoso considereth these words diligently, he findeth therein all that a godly Christian needeth to know of this holy sacrament, as: First, what this holy sacrament is, namely the true body and the true blood of our Lord Jesus Christ, which is given us under bread and wine to eat and to drink, to sustain therewith not the body but the soul. Secondly, these words teach who hath instituted and ordained this sacrament, namely no emperor, kings, man or angel, but our Lord Jesus Christ himself, the emperor of all emperors, king of all kings, the Lord of the angels and of all creatures, the redeemer of mankind, the only-begotten Son of God, who is with the Father and the Holy Ghost of like power and truth, whose will and words come truly to pass and deceive no man, though it seemed to our reason incomprehensible and impossible. Thirdly, these words teach whereto the holy sacrament is profitable and useful to us, namely, first, that we thereby are incorporated into our Lord Christ in faith, and he become one with us and we one with him, unto eternal life, as he himself saith, John 6[:56 and 54]: Whoso eateth my flesh and drinketh of my blood dwelleth in me and I in him, and I will raise him up again at the last day. Secondly, it serveth us also thereto, that we thereby assure our faith in the promises of the gospel of the forgiveness of sins, as with a pure, divine, undeceiving seal and pledge. Thirdly, that we show forth the death of our Lord Christ until his coming again, that is, that we thank him all the days of our life for the redemption, which hath come to pass not through gold or silver (as Peter saith), but through his precious sacrifice and bloodshedding. Lastly, these words teach who they are that receive the holy sacrament savingly to the forgiveness of their sins, namely not the hypocrites, who appear penitent only before men and yet think not to amend their sinful life, but remain after as before full of unchastity, hatred, envy, usury, falsehood, deceit and the like; these eat and drink (as Paul saith) judgment to themselves. But they that repent of their sins from the heart, and firmly believe the forgiveness thereof through the passion, death and bloodshedding of Christ, and earnestly think to amend their life, and so receive this holy sacrament hungry and thirsty for grace and mercy, as oft as they do it, they are here assured by Christ that their sins are forgiven them and shall not be remembered.

That we may now receive the holy sacrament worthily, pray with me thus: Lord God, merciful Father, we beseech thee, help us yet to a true repentance, and cover our sins and unworthiness with the worthiness of thy dear Son Jesus Christ, our Lord, and grant that we may receive this holy sacrament to the strengthening of our faith in the forgiveness of sins, and grow and increase in a new life, that we, thus clothed with the worthiness of thy Son, may be eternally saved, through the same thy Son, our Lord Christ. Amen.

What follows. "another": the editor notes that the order then gives the exhortation "My dearly beloved in God", which Lüneburg 1564 also has in High German, that is, the Braunschweig recension of Osiander (§3.5.4), and that Buxtehude adds the wish "God grant this to us all, that we receive it worthily. Amen" (Sehling 7/1, p. 125). Buxtehude is thus also a witness of §3.5.4.

3.5.14.4 Micron, London 1554, German 1565

Micron's order for the Dutch stranger church at London (Reformed), in the German version of 1565 (with the Norden Dutch variants), has the minister read the institution from 1 Cor 11 from the pulpit and then exhort the congregation to examine itself "before it sit at the table of the Lord". **Micron, *Ordinancien* (1554), German 1565** (Reformed; Sehling 7/1, pp. 631–633):

Ye have heard, dear brethren, out of this doctrine of the holy apostle Paul, who is the institutor of the Supper, namely Christ Jesus, and how it shall be kept, unless one will fall into great danger of the soul. For they that receive it unworthily become guilty of the body and blood of Christ, and eat and drink judgment to themselves. That we then may flee this danger and enjoy the Supper of the Lord worthily, let us, before we sit at the table of the Lord, hear diligently wherein (according to the holy scripture) the right eating of the Supper lieth. The same doth the apostle Paul here set forth in our proving and in the discerning of the body of the Lord, so that every one that sincerely proveth himself and discerneth the body of the Lord goeth worthily to the Supper of the Lord to his soul's comfort and salvation. But this proving and discerning of the body of the Lord, or of his sacrifice, whereby he hath given his body into death for us, lieth chiefly in three points. First, that we confess and bewail from the heart our sins, which we have done against God and our neighbour, and truly reconcile ourselves (so far as it be possible) with all those with whom we have aught at variance. Secondly, that in the knowledge of our sins and in the feeling of the wrath of God against us we become not faint-hearted for our sins' sake, nor fall into despair of his goodness toward us, nor yet take our refuge in human merits, but shall firmly believe that all our sins are forgiven us only out of pure grace, freely, through the only merit of the death of Christ, even as if we ourselves had suffered the death in our own person on the tree of the cross. Thirdly, the right proving of our conscience lieth herein, that we simply, without hypocrisy, purpose a sincere amendment of life according to the holy will of God. Herein then shall every one diligently search his own heart and conscience, how he findeth himself prepared toward God and his neighbour; for whoso will remain stiff-necked in his sins, as in idolatry, blasphemy, covetousness, stealing, lying, deceiving, quarrelling, drunkenness, uncleanness and the like, or who confesseth his sins and yet trusteth in any other than in Jesus Christ and in the merit of his death, or who purposeth not with his whole heart, without hypocrisy, to lead a better life, the same shall not now make haste to come to the Supper of the Lord. But if any should deal otherwise herein, however secretly the same be done, he shall yet before the face of God be guilty of the death of Christ, whom he thus dishonoureth and despiseth.

Yet we say not this, dear brethren, as though we would make the broken hearts of the faithful faint, as if none might go to the Supper of the Lord but he that is free from all uncleanness of sins and perfect in all holiness. For Christ the Lord hath not instituted his Supper for a witness of our holiness or perfection, but much rather for a witness of our imperfection and unrighteousness, which he taketh from us by the sacrifice of his body, and reckoneth to us his righteousness and honour, yea, giveth us the same. And therefore the faithful come to the table of the Lord, not that they may boast of their righteousness and godliness, but much rather to testify that of themselves they are nothing else than children of wrath, sold under sin, and unworthy to lift up their eyes to heaven, whose righteousness, perfection and holiness is Christ alone, who hath taken all our sickness upon himself through his cross, and poureth into us through the Holy Ghost a right desire for righteousness.

Therefore, as many of us as will sit at the table of the Lord for the comfort of their conscience with the wedding garment: Let us accuse ourselves with our whole heart for our sins, and firmly believe that they are not imputed to us, only for Christ's sake. Let us also purpose an earnest amendment of life. And that we may mightily feel and enjoy in our hearts the sweetness of the merit of the death of Christ in the use of the Supper, we shall not remain cleaving to the outward exercise or to the elements of bread and wine, but, admonished thereby, we must lift up our senses, hearts and understanding into heaven, where Jesus Christ alone is according to the body, a faithful advocate for us; and thereby we shall be assured without doubt that we are fed unto eternal life through the spiritual communion of the body and blood of Christ much more surely than our mortal bodies are daily sustained by meat and drink, and than we eat bread and wine in the Supper of the Lord according to the commandment of Christ. God, our heavenly Father, give us his grace, that we may truly taste the true food of our souls, Jesus Christ, in our conscience unto eternal life. Amen.

Notes.

- **The place.** It is read after the Verba, from the pulpit; the minister then goes down to the table and announces 1 Cor 5:7f. ("after this exhortation the minister goeth from the pulpit and standeth with the other ministers by the table; Sehling 7/1, p. 633").
- **Sources.** Sehling's editor compares the second point, on the forgiveness won "on the gallows of the cross", with the third exhortation of Gellius Faber of Emden (Reformed) (Sehling 7/1, p. 632).
- **The *Sursum corda* turned to a doctrine.** "we must lift up our senses, hearts and understanding into heaven, where Jesus Christ alone is according to the body" is the Reformed reading of *Sursum corda* (Lift up your hearts).

- **Moers** (Reformed). The Lower Rhine recension of the Palatinate exhortation (§3.5.10) opens with Micron's words: "Out of this doctrine of the holy apostle Paul ye hear …".

3.5.14.5 Three short notes

- **Marienhafe, *Kirchenordnung*, 1593.** After communion "the preacher maketh a short exhortation of the love of the neighbour", on 1 Cor 10:17 and the figure of many grains and grapes made into one bread and one wine. It turns into the thanksgiving: "so lift up now your hearts to God, beloved, and let us joyfully give thanks" (Sehling 7/1, p. 713). The image of grains and grapes is the one that closes the Palatinate exhortation of 1563 (Reformed; §3.5.10). Sehling's editor also describes the Low German Nürnberg hospital Mass, "De düdesche Misse" (The German Mass) of a Hamburg hymnal of 1558, which has both the Nürnberg and the Bugenhagen exhortations after the *Agnus Dei* (Lamb of God; p. 714).
- **Hohenlohe, *Kirchenordnung*, 1578.** Besides the Brandenburg-Nürnberg exhortation at the altar (§3.5.5), the order appends "exhortations of the holy Supper, to be read at Saturday Vespers to the penitents and communicants" (Sehling 15, p. 327). They are a cycle of eight teaching homilies with a common opening, "Dear friends of Christ, forasmuch as we purpose to keep tomorrow the most worthy and holy Supper", which begins with the words of Luther's address (§3.5.3). The editor traces them to the Saturday sermons of Johann Hofmann (pp. 243, 328).
- **Mecklenburg 1540/45.** Its three Low German exhortations are not printed by Sehling (§3.5.2).

3.6 Before and after the service

3.6.1 Vesting prayers

No vesting prayers survive. None of the evangelical orders in Sehling prints or appoints a vesting prayer, or any of the other prayers in the Lutheran Missal Project's *Vesting Prayers*:

- the psalms of preparation (84, 85, 86, 116, 130) with the antiphon *Ne reminiscaris* (Remember not);
- the Kyrie, Our Father and *preces*;
- the collects;
- the prayers before vesting, at the washing of the hands, and at the amice, alb, cincture, maniple, stole, tunicle, chasuble and mitre.

The searches covered the Latin incipits (*Ne reminiscaris*, *Quam dilecta*, *Benedixisti*, *Inclina, Domine*, *Credidi*, *De profundis* in a preparatory setting), *praeparatio ad missam* (preparation for Mass), *amictus*, *indue me*, and the German and Low German words for vesting. The psalms occur only in the Office and the Introits.

The only mention of the medieval prayers is an editor's note. Sehling's editor, on the Amberg hospital order of 1544, distinguishes the three preparations of the priest before Mass. **Amberg, *Ordnung der kirchen … im spital*, 1544, editor's note** (Sehling 13, p. 282):

What is here set before the Introit, in this noteworthy attempt, as a preparation for the congregation instead of the prayers at the foot of the altar (with the Confiteor), which are a preparation of the celebrating clergyman, is probably a form of the *accessus*. This is the first of the three prescribed preparations of the clergyman. It was not, like the *Praeparatio ad missam* (preparation for Mass) that followed it (with, among other things, the prayers at the putting on of the several parts of the Mass vesture), and that which then came within the Mass itself in the form of the prayers at the foot of the altar, exactly prescribed in its form in the Missal, and could therefore differ quite widely by place and person, and could also take the form of a devotion with which priests prepared themselves together for the celebration of Mass.

What the orders do say about vesting. The orders mention vesting only as a rubric, and only to say that it signifies nothing. The vestments themselves are indifferent. **Brandenburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1540** (Sehling 3, p. 65):

The other additions of outward bodily things, as Mass vestment, altar cloth, silver and golden vessels, lights, etc., are altogether free; they give and take nothing to faith and conscience. Therefore, since they were there before and have been provided, they shall be kept and used, especially the vestments, because the ministers of the church are not always so furnished in their own clothes that they might serve the congregation therein worthily and honourably.

The rubrics on vesting say no more than this:

- **The moment of vesting.** At Hadeln the priest vests during the *Te Deum* (We praise thee, O God) at the end of Matins, "not as needful, but as a seemly and honest ornament, and not seeking salvation therein" (§3.3.4). In Mecklenburg 1540 the priest turns to the people "when he hath vested himself" (§3.3.4). In both, vesting is done in silence, in the church or sacristy, with no prayer.
- **The *Stufengebet***, the third of the medieval preparations, is the only one that survives (§3.3.2–3.3.4). The *accessus* survives, recast, only as the congregation's *Veni Sancte Spiritus* (Come, Holy Spirit) (§3.3.7).

3.6.2 The psalms and the *Ne reminiscaris*

None of the five preparatory psalms of the Missal's *praeparatio* is appointed as a private preparation of the minister, and the antiphon *Ne reminiscaris* (Remember not; Tobit 3:3) does not occur.

- **The nearest thing** is Bugenhagen's *Domine, ne memineris iniquitatum nostrarum antiquarum* (O Lord, remember not our former iniquities) (Ps 79:8), said with the sexton at the altar step (§3.3.3). It is the same plea for the forgetting of old sins, but taken from the Lenten tract.
- **Penitential psalms.** Pfalz-Neuburg 1543 allows "a goodly penitential psalm" in place of the *Confiteor* (I confess; §3.3.2). Ps 130 *De profundis* (Out of the depths) appears as a hymn, Luther's *Aus tiefer Not* (Out of deep distress), sung as the Introit in Lippe (§3.3.4) and often elsewhere.
- **The psalms themselves** occur in the corpus only as Introits, Office psalms, or proof texts. Ps 84 *Quam dilecta* (How amiable) is the dedication psalm at Hof 1592 (Sehling 11, p. 422), and Lüneburg 1564 cites it in defence of public worship (Sehling 6/1, p. 541).

3.6.3 After the Mass

The priest's private thanksgiving. The medieval *gratiarum actio post missam*, the thanksgiving after Mass (the canticle *Benedicite* [Bless ye], Ps 150 *Laudate Dominum in sanctis eius* [Praise ye the Lord in his sanctuary], and collects, said by the priest while unvesting) survives in only one form. In Bugenhagen's Hildesheim order of 1544 and the Schleswig-Holstein order of 1542, the priest unvests during the closing hymn, kneels again before the altar, and "thanketh God secretly for himself" (Sehling 7/2.1, p. 855; Sehling 23, p. 91). No text is given. Both are quoted with translations in Chapter 7 §§7.15.2–7.15.3.

The Benedicite and Ps 150. Neither is appointed after Mass in any evangelical order. Both occur only as the canticle and psalm of **Sunday Lauds**, sung in the choir by the schoolboys or the canons. Pomerania prescribes the weekday canticles of Lauds after the *Te Deum* (We praise thee, O God). **Pomerania, *Pia ordinatio caeremoniarum*, 1535** (Sehling 4, p. 349):

After the third responsory, which is sung with the Gloria Patri, etc., let the Te Deum follow, etc. Next let the cantor begin some antiphon, according to whose tone there shall be sung only one of the prophetic psalms, which are called canticles: on the Lord's Day, *Benedicite omnia* (O all ye works, bless ye), etc.; on Monday, *Confitebor tibi, Domine, quoniam iratus* (I will praise thee, O Lord, though thou wast angry), etc.; on Tuesday, *Ego dixi*, etc.; on Wednesday, *Exultavit* (hath rejoiced), etc.; on Thursday, *Cantemus* (Let us sing), etc.; on Friday, *Domine, audivi* (O Lord, I have heard), etc.; on Saturday, *Audite coeli* (Hear, O heavens), etc.

The Schleswig-Holstein order of 1542 has the same scheme in Low German, "on Sundays: *Benedicite omnia*" (Sehling 23, p. 141). At the Ansbach collegiate churches Sunday Lauds keeps both the *Benedicite* and the *Laudate* psalms. **Brandenburg-Ansbach, *Ordnung singens und lesens bei den Stiften*, 1533** (Sehling 11, p. 313):

On Sunday they sing the Te Deum laudamus; thereafter the psalms *Dominus regnavit* (The Lord reigneth), *Jubilate Deo omnis terra* (Make a joyful noise unto God, all ye lands), *Deus, Deus meus* (O God, my God), *Benedicite omnia opera* (O all ye works, bless ye), *Laudate Dominum de coelis* (Praise ye the Lord from the heavens), with the antiphon *Indutus est* (He is clothed); the *Benedictus Dominus* (Blessed be the Lord), etc., as is otherwise customarily held on Sunday.

Who sings them. At Ansbach, "they": the canons and vicars of the collegiate foundations. In Pomerania and Schleswig-Holstein, the cantor and the schoolboys in the choir. The people are not present at Lauds. The *Laudate* psalms (Pss 148–150) are sung under the one heading "Laudate Dominum de coelis".

What the orders do appoint after Mass. In place of the priest's private thanksgiving, the evangelical Mass ends with a public thanksgiving by all:

- a postcommunion collect, usually Luther's "Wir danken dir, allmächtiger Herr Gott" (We give thanks to thee, almighty Lord God);
- the Aaronic blessing;
- a hymn or psalm sung by the schoolboys and people while the communicants return, or at the very end. At Hildesheim it is "a short German psalm" begun by the schoolmaster.

In Kantz 1522 and in Nürnberg the *Nunc dimittis* is sung after communion. The collects and thanksgiving prayers are treated in Chapter 5, and the hymns in Chapter 8.

3.6.4 Prayers before and after the sermon

The pattern. Every Lutheran order surrounds the sermon with prayer. The preacher calls the people to prayer before he begins, and they pray, usually the Our Father in silence or aloud, or sing a hymn to the Holy Ghost. At the end of the sermon he calls them again to thanksgiving and to intercession for the Church, the government and all need, and leads the general prayer. The Lüneburg order puts it most fully. **Lüneburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1564** (Sehling 6/1, pp. 544–545):

But before the sermon the priest is to exhort the people to Christian prayer, that the dear God would give them his Holy Ghost, to handle his holy word profitably and to take it into the heart, that they may amend their sinful life, obtain comfort and strengthening of their faith, and henceforth live christianly and blessedly. Thereupon an Our Father shall be said, or *Nu bitten wir den heiligen Geist* (Now pray we the Holy Ghost) sung; about Christmas, *Ein kindelein so löbelich* (A little child so praiseworthy), etc.; about Easter, *Christ ist erstanden* (Christ is arisen), etc. At the end of the sermon the people shall again be exhorted to prayer and thanksgiving toward God, and [shall pray] together for the preservation of the Church of God and right doctrine, and thereto of faithful, true teachers, and that God would send faithful labourers into his harvest; for the government, for temporal peace and the increase of the fruits; and in sum for the need of all Christendom and of particular persons that desire the Christian prayer.

Other orders.

- **Luther 1526**: "that the common prayer is made in the pulpit, or the Our Father said before [the people]", remains from the old pulpit office (§3.5.3).
- **Mecklenburg 1552**: at the end of the sermon the people are "exhorted to prayer and thanksgiving", and the preacher is to bid them "that they remain in the church at the communion" (Sehling 5, p. 198). Lüneburg copies it.
- **Hadeln**: the preacher "shall first exhort the people to diligent calling upon the help of God". After the sermon he again exhorts to prayer, recites the Small Catechism, and prays for the prince, the preachers "and all needs" (Sehling 5, p. 468).
- **Buxtehude 1552**: the chaplains "shall begin all their sermons with a hymn, to pray God for his grace" (Sehling 7/1, p. 72).
- **Hanau-Lichtenberg 1573**, weekday sermons: "before the sermon sing a psalm; then follow an Our Father and the sermon; lastly close the sermon with hymn, prayer and blessing" (Sehling 20/2, p. 53). In the villages without a school the pastor sings a German psalm, then "let him recite the open confession, absolution and epistle" (ibid.).
- **Palatinate 1563** (Reformed): the prayer of confession before the sermon, ending in the Our Father, said by the minister (§3.3.6); the confession, absolution and the long general prayer after it (§3.4.4).

The pulpit prayers, the greeting and the notices are treated more fully in Chapter 11 §11.10.

Who prays. The preacher bids and leads; the congregation prays the Our Father with him or silently, and answers "Amen". The schoolboys and choir sing the hymn. No order gives a private prayer for the preacher to say before going up into the pulpit. Pfalz-Veldenz 1574 has him begin the sermon "with the prayer, as is customary" (Sehling 18, p. 499), and leaves the text to custom.

3.6.5 On entering and leaving church; the communicants' own prayers

On entering church. No order in the corpus prints or appoints a prayer for the worshipper to say on entering or leaving the church. The modern hymnal's "prayer on entering church" has no sixteenth-century church-order counterpart. What the orders appoint "when one comes into church" is a hymn:

- **Sayn 1590**: "First, when one cometh into the church, a German psalm shall be sung; thereafter the pastor shall read a collect" (Sehling 19/1, p. 412).
- **Pfalz-Zweibrücken 1557**: an opening hymn of the Holy Ghost is sung "until the church cometh together" (§3.3.4).

- **Amberg 1550**, weekday morning prayer: the priest begins *Deus in adiutorium* (O God, make speed to save me), and the choir sings one or two Latin psalms "until the people come together" (Sehling 13, p. 287).

The orders regulate behaviour instead: the people are not to stand about in the churchyard or run in and out during the sermon. The village ordinance of Obereisenheim (Castell) of 1579 wants each to go into church when the bell is rung, to "hear God's word, wait upon the sermon, and finish his prayer with the whole congregation quietly and still" (Sehling 11, p. 688).

The communicants' prayers. The orders print no private prayers for the communicant to say before or after receiving. What the communicant does is set out in three ways:

1. **Private preparation** by confession and examination on the Saturday (§3.4.6).
2. **Prayers said for them by the minister**:
   - Pfalz-Veldenz 1574 has a "Prayer before the Supper", read by the minister to the people after the absolution. It asks "that thou wouldest graciously give unto all of us that shall eat and drink of this thy holy Supper the blessed communion of thy body and blood" (Sehling 18, p. 499).
   - Micron's Dutch order (Reformed) has a "prayer before the Supper", said by the minister from the pulpit while all kneel (Sehling 7/1, p. 630).
   - Ysenburg 1588 prints more than one prayer after communion, all collects of the minister (Sehling 10, p. 627).
3. **Hymns sung during the distribution.** *Jesus Christus unser Heiland* (Jesus Christ our Saviour), *Gott sei gelobet* (God be praised), the German *Agnus Dei* (Lamb of God): the hymns are the people's prayer during communion. Mecklenburg 1552 tells the communicants "ye shall also here make your hearty prayer", and gives the prayer in the first person, to be made their own (§3.5.9).

The hymnal. The nearest thing to the modern hymnal's printed devotions is the Pfalz-Zweibrücken *Gesangbuch* (hymnal) of 1571/1587. It reprints the Mecklenburg confession, prayer and absolution as "Confession, prayer and absolution before the sermon on Sunday", so that the people had the text in their hands (Sehling 18, p. 187, apparatus).

A note on "Benedicite". In the household sections of the orders, "Benedicite" (Bless ye) and "Gratias" (Thanks) are the grace before and after meat of Luther's Small Catechism ("The eyes of all wait upon thee, O Lord" and "O give thanks unto the Lord, for he is good"). It is not the canticle of the three children. Pfalz-Zweibrücken 1557 heads it "How a householder shall teach his household to say the Benedicite and Gratias" (Sehling 18, p. 180).

3.7 Table by order

The table gives, for each order discussed in §3.3 and §3.4 and for the orders with an exhortation of their own (§3.5.14), what stands before the Introit, how the confession is said and absolved, and where the exhortation falls. Every cell has been checked against the text of the order. "—" means the order has nothing of the kind; "not stated" means the order mentions the item but gives no text or form. "A"–"G" are the families of §3.3.1; absolution types 1–5 are those of §3.4.4. The orders that appear only as witnesses to an exhortation are listed in the witness tables of §3.5.3–3.5.13.

Order	Opening before the Introit	Confession: who and where	Absolution (type)	Exhortation (family; place)	§
Kantz, Nördlingen 1522	Exhortation, absolution, *Adiutorium* (Our help), *Veni Sancte Spiritus* (Come, Holy Spirit) (D)	No confession text; before the Sacrament	"declare you free, quit and loosed" (3)	Free, with a short address leading to the absolution; before the Preface	3.3.5, 3.4.3, 3.5.14.1
Müntzer, Allstedt 1523 and 1524 (Radical Reformation)	Ps 43 with priest and people; priest's confession; people's *Misereatur* (May [almighty God] have mercy); *Deus, tu conversus* (O God, thou wilt turn again); *Non*	Priest, aloud "before all the people"; the people answer	—	—	3.3.8

Order	Opening before the Introit	Confession: who and where	Absolution (type)	Exhortation (family; place)	§
	nobis (Not unto us); *Aufer a nobis* (Take away from us) (G)				
Volprecht, Nürnberg 1524	*Offene beicht* (open confession) "in place of the Confiteor" (D)	Priest, to God and the brothers and sisters	"God hath had mercy upon us" (2)	Osiander (V); printed after the Mass, for days with communicants	3.3.5, 3.5.4
Wertheim 1524 (Kolb)	Sermon	Priest kneeling, "a very short Confiteor" in German, after the sermon	—	None before communion ("without any exhortation"); a short exhortation to thanksgiving after communion, and one "for preparation" in the sermon	3.3.6
Döber, Nürnberg 1525	Address, *Adiutorium*, *Confitemini* (O give thanks), confession, *Misereatur*, declaration, *Veni Sancte Spiritus* (C)	Priest kneeling; people "say after me"	Optative (1), then declaration (2)	Osiander; after the Our Father	3.3.4, 3.5.4
Bremen, *Evangelische Misse*, 1525	Address, absolution, *Adiutorium*, *Veni Sancte Spiritus* (D)	No confession text; the priest asks the people's prayer ("The priest's confession")	"declare you free, quit and loosed" (3)	Free, with Kantz's address in Low German; before the Preface	3.3.5, 3.5.14.1
Luther, *Deutsche Messe* 1526	German hymn or psalm (F)	—	—	Luther; after the sermon, pulpit or altar	3.3.7, 3.5.3
Hadeln ("1526")	Priest vests during the *Te Deum* (We praise thee, O God); *Veni Sancte Spiritus* kneeling (C, F)	Priest sings it kneeling; the sexton answers	Read by the sexton; later given up	Bugenhagen ("My dearly beloved etc."); after the sermon, before the Preface	3.3.4, 3.5.7
Kiel, *Deutsche Messe* [after 1526]	Address and confession (C)	Priest; minister and sexton read the *Misereatur*	Read by the sexton (3)	After the Preface and bread-word (Chapter 7 §7.11.3)	3.3.4
Lippe, *Deutsche Messe* [1525–1538]	*Adiutorium*, *Confitemini*, confession (C)	Priest reads it while the choir sings the Introit	Optative, headed "absolutio" (absolution) (1)	— (Creed, offertory hymn, Preface)	3.3.4
Bugenhagen, Brunswick 1528	Introit or German psalm	Preacher and people, from the pulpit after the sermon, with the Creed	None; "Jesus Christ is our salvation" (5)	Bugenhagen; at the altar, in place of the Preface	3.4.4, 3.5.7

Order	Opening before the Introit	Confession: who and where	Absolution (type)	Exhortation (family; place)	§
Augsburg, St. Anna, 1530 (Moderate Reformed)	Not stated (the order covers the Supper only)	None in the first form	In the second exhortation: "I declare you all … free of your sins" (3)	Two of its own; before the Verba and after them	3.5.14.2
Brandenburg-Nürnberg 1533	Priest's *Confiteor* (I confess) "or what his devotion puts him in mind of" (A)	Priest alone	— (the *Offene Schuld* [open confession] added at Nürnberg after 1569)	Brandenburg-Nürnberg; after the sermon, before the Verba	3.3.2, 3.5.5
Württemberg 1536	*Veni Sancte* (Come, Holy [Spirit]) in German, psalms (Saturday admonition in the choir)	Pastor says it for all after the exhortation	Three forms, indicative (3)	Württemberg; at the altar after the sermon	3.4.4, 3.5.6
Naumburg 1537	*Kom heiliger geist* (Come, Holy Ghost) sung by the choir (D, F)	Priest leads; people say it	"I forgive you all your sins" (3)	Naumburg; to the communicants gathered in the choir, before the Sanctus	3.3.5, 3.5.8
Strasbourg 1537 (Moderate Reformed)	"Confiteor or open confession" (E)	Minister; each "in his heart"	Comfortable word, conditional (4)	Free: at the end of the sermon, in four points, or briefly after the prayer and Our Father, before the Verba	3.3.6
Mecklenburg 1540/45	Address, *Adiutorium*, *Confitemini*, confession (C); German psalm in villages	Priest kneeling with the sexton "or another Christian"; people silent	Optative by the minister (1), declaration by the priest (2)	Three Low German exhortations, one at a time; not printed by Sehling	3.3.4, 3.5.2
Brandenburg 1540	Priest's *Confiteor* with ministrants (A)	Priest and ministrants	— (common confession forbidden)	Brandenburg-Nürnberg; after the consecration	3.3.2, 3.4.6, 3.5.5
Regensburg, *Wahrhaftiger Bericht*, 1542	Litany; meanwhile the priest says the *Confiteor* with the gospeller (A); a collect, perhaps *Aufer a nobis*	Priest and gospeller, privately; an open confession after the exhortation	Indicative, in the exhortation of c. 1544 (3)	Brandenburg-Nürnberg (Regensburg c. 1544); read by the gospeller after the Creed	3.3.8, 3.5.5
Schleswig-Holstein 1542	Priest's *Confiteor* "for himself", with intercession (A)	Priest alone	—	"an exhortation to the Sacrament", not printed; when the communicants have come to the altar, before the Our Father and Verba	3.3.2, 3.6.3

Order	Opening before the Introit	Confession: who and where	Absolution (type)	Exhortation (family; place)	§
Pfalz-Neuburg 1543	Priest's *Confiteor* or a penitential psalm, kneeling (A)	Priest and ministrants	— (common confession forbidden)	Brandenburg-Nürnberg	3.3.2, 3.4.6, 3.5.5
Wolfenbüttel 1543	German Benedictus or psalm; Bugenhagen's prayer (B)	Priest and sexton kneeling	—	Bugenhagen	3.3.3, 3.5.7
Bergedorf 1544	Pastor kneels at the foot of the altar for "his prayer" (A); German psalm or Latin Introit	Pastor alone; a form of confession recited to the people after the sermon, for teaching	—	Bugenhagen ("as it is read at Hamburg"); after the sermon and hymn, before the Preface	3.3.2, 3.5.7
Hildesheim 1544	German psalm; Bugenhagen's prayer (B)	Priest and *opperman* (sexton) kneeling	—	Bugenhagen	3.3.3, 3.6.3
Amberg hospital 1544	*Veni Sancte* by schoolmaster and boys; German collect and versicle (F)	Open confession after the sermon and general prayer	"open absolution", not stated	Not stated; by the priest at the altar, after the litany	3.3.7, 3.6.1
Nördlingen 1544	*Kum, heiliger Geist* (Come, Holy Ghost) or *Nun bitten wir* (Now pray we) by two choirs (A, D, F)	Celebrant's *Confiteor*, absolved by a fellow minister; then open confession to the people	Not stated	"a short exhortation", not printed (Naumburg, according to Sehling's editor); before the Sanctus	3.3.2, 3.5.8
Cellische Ordnungen, 1545	Not stated (the rubrics begin with the sermon)	Private confession only	—	— ; *Aufer a nobis* sung in Latin after the sermon	3.3.8
Transylvania 1547	German Benedictus, or the litany; *Salve festa dies* (Hail, festal day) at Easter (F)	—	—	— (Creed, Preface, Our Father, Verba)	3.3.7
Amberg 1550	Priest's *Confiteor* kneeling; choir *Haec est dies* (This is the day) or *Veni Sancte*; collect (A, F)	Priest; open confession after the sermon; people repeat it at weekday prayer	—	Not stated; Sehling's editor thinks it Luther's	3.3.2, 3.4.4
Buxtehude, *Kirchenordnung*, 1552	German psalm, *Kum, hilliger Geist* (Come, Holy Ghost) on weekdays (F)	Priest at the altar's foot, during the Introit (A)	—	Bugenhagen ("My dearly beloved in Christ")	3.3.2, 3.5.7
Mecklenburg 1552	Address, *Adiutorium*, confession (C)	Priest kneeling with another minister or the custos; choir answers; people silent	Optative by the second minister (1), declaration (2); indicative in the exhortation (3/4)	Mecklenburg; after the Sanctus, if there is time	3.3.4, 3.4.5, 3.5.9

Order	Opening before the Introit	Confession: who and where	Absolution (type)	Exhortation (family; place)	§
Hohenlohe 1553	"The pure Confiteor in Latin" (A)	Pastor alone, kneeling; then a common confession from the pulpit after the exhortation (from Huberinus)	Comfortable word (John 6:51) and "I declare unto you such forgiveness" (3)	Brandenburg-Nürnberg; from the pulpit after the sermon	3.3.2, 3.5.5
Regensburg 1553	*Confiteor* (A)	Priest kneeling with the second ministrant; private confession on Saturday	Private absolution on Saturday	Brandenburg-Nürnberg (Regensburg c. 1544); read by the second minister after the Creed	3.3.2, 3.5.5
Amberg 1555	*Veni Sancte*; *Adiutorium*; the Mecklenburg form in the plural (C)	Priest kneeling with another minister; the church silent, confessing with him	Declaration (2)	"the exhortation used hitherto", not printed; before the Preface	3.3.4
Micron, London 1554, German 1565 (Reformed)	Bidding and prayer from the pulpit; after the sermon, the Ten Commandments and confession (E)	Minister, for the congregation	Conditional declaration (4)	Micron's own; from the pulpit after the Verba	3.3.6, 3.5.14.4
Kurpfalz 1556	Introit, Kyrie, *Et in terra* (And on earth)	Open confession after the sermon on Sundays, and at the preparation before communion	Two indicative forms: "I declare unto you … such forgiveness" and "declare you free, quit and loosed" (3)	Württemberg 1553	3.4.1, 3.5.6
Pfalz-Zweibrücken 1557	Hymn of the Holy Ghost until the church gathers; Mecklenburg form (C, F)	As Mecklenburg 1552	As Mecklenburg 1552 (1, 2)	Mecklenburg	3.3.4, 3.5.9
Palatinate 1563 (Reformed)	Greeting; prayer of confession before the sermon (E)	Minister; people "say with me"; after the sermon	Conditional, with retention (4); Supper examination (5)	Palatinate; at the table	3.3.6, 3.4.4, 3.5.10
Lüneburg 1564	Introit	Private confession on Saturday after Vespers; a short form of confession read before the sermons, for teaching	Private	Osiander (Braunschweig recension), or Bugenhagen	3.5.4, 3.5.7, 3.6.4
Buxtehude, *Agende*, 1565	(see 1552)	(see 1552)	—	Its own, then Osiander (Braunschweig	3.5.14.3

Order	Opening before the Introit	Confession: who and where	Absolution (type)	Exhortation (family; place)	§
				recension); after the Prefaces	
Nürnberg, Dietrich 1569	Introit	Appended to the exhortation	"If ye do this, I loose you" (3/4)	Brandenburg-Nürnberg	3.4.4, 3.5.5
Hanau-Lichtenberg 1573	German psalm; open confession in villages	Pastor; after the exhortation	Württemberg form: "I declare unto you" (3)	Württemberg 1553	3.5.6, 3.6.4
Pfalz-Veldenz 1574	*Nun bitten wir* or *Khom, heiliger Geist* (Come, Holy Ghost), kneeling; Mecklenburg form (C, F)	Minister alone, kneeling	Declaration (2)	Pfalz-Veldenz's own, with the Mecklenburg prayer	3.3.4, 3.5.11
Sayn 1590	German psalm "when one cometh into the church"; collect (F)	—	—	Mecklenburg, abridged	3.3.7, 3.5.9, 3.6.5
Marienhafe 1593	The Supper follows the sermon and prayer; the communicants gather in the choir during *Herr Christ, du einiger Gottessohn* (Lord Christ, thou only Son of God)	Private "special exhortation and absolution" beforehand; in the rite a prayer of confession in the plural, "we poor, sinful men confess", after the *Agnus Dei* (Lamb of God)	None in the rite (Sehling's editor notes its absence)	On a preaching day before; a short one on 1 Cor 11:26 after the *Agnus Dei*; its own after communion	3.4.5, 3.5.14.5
Verden 1606	*Veni Sancte Spiritus*, *Emitte Spiritum*, *Deus qui corda* (O God, who … the hearts) (F)	—	—	Osiander (Braunschweig recension), or Bugenhagen	3.3.7, 3.5.4, 3.5.7

3.8 Concordance of the orders quoted

The concordance. Every order quoted in this chapter is listed below, with the volume and pages of Sehling and the sections where it is quoted. Orders cited only in summary can be found through the table in §3.7 and the text.

Order	Title	Date	Sehling	Quoted in §
Albertine Saxony	*Die Cellischen Ordnungen*	1545	1, p. 300	3.3.8
Allstedt, Thomas Müntzer (Radical Reformation)	*Deutsch evangelisch Messe*	1524	1, p. 499	3.3.8
Amberg	*Ordnung der kirchen … im spital*	1544	13, p. 282	3.3.7, 3.6.1
Amberg	*Kirchenordnung*	1550	13, pp. 285, 286–287	3.3.2, 3.4.4
Amberg	*Kirchenordnung*	1555	13, p. 290	3.3.4
Augsburg (Moderate Reformed)	*Form und ordnung des Herren nachtmal*	1530	12, pp. 40–41, 42	3.5.14

Order	Title	Date	Sehling	Quoted in §
Bergedorf	*Kirchenordnung*	1544	5, p. 387	3.3.2
Brandenburg	*Kirchenordnung*	1540	3, pp. 60, 65, 67–68	3.3.2, 3.4.6, 3.6.1
Brandenburg-Ansbach	*Ordnung singens und lesens bei den Stiften*	1533	11, p. 313	3.6.3
Brandenburg-Nürnberg	*Kirchenordnung*	1533	11, pp. 188, 195–196	3.3.2, 3.5.5
Bremen	*Eyne evangelysce Misse*	1525	7/2.2, p. 405	3.5.14
Brunswick	*Christlike ordeninge* of Johannes Bugenhagen	1528	6/1, pp. 443, 443–444	3.4.4, 3.5.7
Buxtehude	*Kirchenordnung*	1552	7/1, p. 74	3.3.2
Buxtehude	*Agende*	1565	7/1, pp. 124–125	3.5.14
Hadeln	*Kirchenordnung*	"of 1526"	5, pp. 467–468	3.3.4
Henneberg	*Kirchenordnung* of Georg Ernst	1582	2, p. 308	3.5.3
Hohenlohe	*Kirchenordnung*	1553	15, p. 68	3.3.2
Lippe	*Deutsche Messe*	[c. 1525–1538]	22, p. 565	3.3.4
Lüneburg	*Kirchenordnung*	1564	6/1, pp. 544–545, 547	3.5.4, 3.6.4
Mecklenburg	*Ordeninge der misse*	1540/1545	5, pp. 150–151	3.3.4
Mecklenburg	*Kirchenordnung*	1552	5, pp. 197–198, 202–204	3.3.4, 3.5.9
Memmingen (Moderate Reformed)	*Kirchenordnung*	1528	12, p. 245	3.5.12
Micron (Reformed)	*Ordinancien* (1554), German	1565	7/1, pp. 631–633	3.5.14
Moers (Reformed)	*Kirchenordnung*	1581	22, p. 197	3.5.10
Nassau-Weilburg	*Agende*	1618	10, p. 264	3.5.9
Naumburg	*Kirchen-Ordnung* for St. Wenzel's	1537	2, pp. 77–78, 80	3.3.5, 3.5.8
Neckarbischofsheim	*Kirchenordnung*	1560	16, p. 683	3.5.12
Nördlingen	*Kirchenordnung* of Kaspar Löner	1544	12, pp. 311–312	3.3.2
Nürnberg	*Deutsche Messe* of the prior Volprecht	1524	11, pp. 39–40	3.3.5
Nürnberg	*Gottesdienstordnung der Pfarrkirchen* (base text of *Grundt und ursach*)	1524	11, pp. 48–49	3.5.4
Nürnberg, Andreas Döber	*Von der evangelischen meß … im Newen Spital*	1525	11, p. 51	3.3.4
Nürnberg, Veit Dietrich	*Agendbüchlein*	edition of 1569	11, p. 498	3.4.4
Osnabrück (city)	*Kirchenordnung*	1613	7/1, p. 269	3.5.7

Order	Title	Date	Sehling	Quoted in §
Palatinate (Reformed)	*Kirchenordnung*	1563	14, pp. 383, 383–386, 388, 389	3.3.6, 3.4.4, 3.5.10
Pfalz-Neuburg	*Kirchenordnung*	1543	13, p. 70	3.3.2
Pfalz-Veldenz	*Kirchenordnung*	1574	18, pp. 498–499, 500–501	3.3.4, 3.5.11
Pfalz-Zweibrücken	*Kirchenordnung*	1557	18, p. 187	3.3.4
Pomerania	*Pia ordinatio caeremoniarum*	1535	4, p. 349	3.6.3
Prussia	*Kirchenordnung*	1544	4, p. 65	3.5.3
Regensburg	*Kirchenordnung* under Justus Jonas	1553	13, pp. 419–420	3.3.2
Schleswig-Holstein	*Deutsche Messe* (Kiel)	[after 1526]	23, p. 55	3.3.4
Strasbourg (Moderate Reformed)	*Die frühen Agenden*	1525	20/1, pp. 158–159	3.5.13
Strasbourg (Moderate Reformed)	*Agende*	1537/1541	20/1, p. 270	3.3.6
Transylvania	*Kirchenordnung*	1547	24, p. 223	3.3.7
Verden	*Kirchenordnung*	1606	7/1, pp. 155–156	3.3.7
Wertheim	*Kirchenordnung*	c. 1555	11, p. 713	3.5.3
Wertheim	Letter of Franz Kolb to Luther	27 August 1524	11, p. 707	3.3.6
Wittenberg, Luther	*Deudsche messe und ordnung gottis diensts*	1526	1, pp. 14, 15	3.3.7, 3.5.3
Württemberg	*Kirchenordnung*	1536	16, pp. 107–108, 108–109	3.4.4, 3.5.6

Chapter 4. The Propers of the Mass

This chapter follows the **propers of the Mass**, the parts that change with the day, through the evangelical church orders printed in Emil Sehling's *Die evangelischen Kirchenordnungen des XVI. Jahrhunderts* (The Evangelical Church Orders of the Sixteenth Century). The propers covered are the introit, the prophecy or Old Testament lesson, the epistle, the gradual, the alleluia and tract, the gospel, the offertory, the Proper Preface and the communion chant. For each it asks:

- Was it **kept**, and where?
- **Who sang or read it**: the cantor and the school choir, the celebrant, the congregation, the organ? Was it sung in alternation?
- Was it in **Latin or German**?
- Were the **historic tunes** kept, cut, or replaced with new music: new tones, polyphony?

For the **Proper Prefaces** it asks also:

- On which days of the season, feast or saint were they used?
- Which Prefaces did each order have?

Appendix 4.A renders every Proper Preface in the corpus:

- in the original language, Latin and German or Low German;
- with a formal-equivalence translation in the idiom of the Authorized Version;
- with the list of the orders that carry each text.

Where the corpus has both the Latin and a German translation, both are given. The English is then made from the Latin, with notes on where the German shortens, adds to or changes it.

How the chapter is laid out.

- §4.1 summarizes the findings, and §4.2 sets out the method and cautions.
- §4.3 describes the three ways the orders dealt with the propers.
- §§4.4–4.9 take the propers in turn: introit, lessons, gradual, offertory, Preface, communion.
- §4.10 deals with the music.
- §4.11 is a table by order, and §4.12 a concordance.

4.1 Summary of findings

1. Three models, often combined. The orders handle the propers in one of three ways (§4.3):

- **Keep them in Latin**, sung by the school choir: the *Formula missae* (Form of the Mass) line.
- **Translate them into German prose**, sung to the old tones: Müntzer 1524 (Radical Reformation), Erfurt 1525, Calenberg-Göttingen 1542.
- **Replace them with German hymns** sung by the congregation: the *Deutsche Messe* (German Mass) line.

Most territorial orders allowed all three by place and day:

- Latin "where there is a school", "in the towns", "on the feasts";
- German psalms "in the villages" and on ordinary Sundays.

The constant condition is that a proper must be **from Scripture and "pure"**. In practice this meant ***de tempore*, not *de sanctis*** (§4.3.1, §4.6.2).

2. The introit was the most widely kept proper (§4.4).

- **Luther's approval.** Luther approved the Sunday and festal introits "if taken from Scripture" (1523).
- **Who sang it.** The **school** sang it in Latin, under the cantor or schoolmaster, while the priest read it quietly. Villages sang a German psalm instead.
- **Fallbacks.** Where boys could not learn every Sunday's introit, they repeated *Benedicta sit sancta Trinitas* (Blessed be the holy Trinity) or *Spiritus Domini* (The Spirit of the Lord; Hatzkerode, Heilbronn, Kurpfalz, Hamburg 1556).

- **German introits.** These appear in Müntzer (Radical Reformation), Erfurt and Hof 1592. Wittgenstein 1555 allows the festal introits to be sung in German in the villages.
- **Organ and polyphony.** By the later century the introit was often played by the organ in alternation with the choir, or sung *figuraliter* (in figured music; Nördlingen 1579, Hof 1592).

3. No Old Testament "prophecy" before the epistle survives as a regular lesson (§4.5.1).

- **At the Mass.** The prophetic lessons that remain are the historic epistles taken from a prophet (Hof 1592). On some feasts a chapter of the feast's history is read instead (Pfalz-Neuburg 1543).
- **At the office.** Old Testament lessons belong to Matins and Vespers. They were read in the old **prophecy tone**, whose cadence is written out in solmization (Hamburg 1529, Pomerania 1535, Wittenberg 1533).

4. The epistle and gospel of the day were kept everywhere, and read toward the people (§4.5.2–4.5.3).

- **Exceptions.** Müntzer (Radical Reformation), and Nürnberg and Brandenburg-Nürnberg in the 1520s–30s, read whole chapters in sequence.
- **Three practices of language and tone:**
  - **German in new tones.** Luther's *Deutsche Messe* has the epistle in the eighth tone and the gospel in the fifth. The Saxon orders send pastors to copy "the tone and accent customary at Wittenberg".
  - **German read without notes**, for intelligibility (Mecklenburg).
  - **Latin chanted "in the old customary melody", then read in German** (Schwäbisch Hall 1526, Hamburg 1556, Brieg 1592). Brandenburg's visitors required this in 1573.

5. The gradual and alleluia survived as a Latin choir piece, cut short (§4.6).

- **Cut short.** Luther limited the gradual to two verses, and kept the alleluia in Lent as "the perpetual voice of the church". Bugenhagen's northern orders cut off the jubilus, "the many notes which one was wont to hang on behind".
- **Replaced.** In villages, and where the text was "not pure", a German psalm took the place.
- **German graduals.** Müntzer (Radical Reformation) and Erfurt have them. Nürnberg sang its gradual "in a tone made for it".

6. The offertory chant was the proper most often dropped (§4.7).

- **Dropped.** It went with the offertory prayers as part of the "abomination" of sacrifice (Luther 1523). Volprecht says it is "never said, because Christ was once offered for our sins".
- **Kept.** A few orders kept the Latin offertory as a Scripture text sung by the choir: Wittenberg 1525, Brandenburg 1540, Ansbach 1548, Amberg 1550.
- **Translated.** Müntzer (Radical Reformation) and Erfurt translated it.
- **Replaced.** Most replaced it with a German psalm or the creed hymn.

7. The Proper Preface survived chiefly on the feasts, in Latin, to the Missal tones (§4.8).

- **Cut.** Luther cut the Preface short in 1523 and dropped it in 1526. Prussia abolished it outright.
- **The usual rule.** Most orders from Duke Henry's Saxon order of 1539 on adopted the rule: **the Latin Preface on the feasts, the exhortation on ordinary Sundays**.
- **The feasts.** The proper Prefaces were those of the feasts of Christ: Christmas, Epiphany, Easter, Ascension, Pentecost, Trinity.
- **Ordinary Sundays.** Bugenhagen's northern orders chose the **Trinity Preface** "made against the Arians" (Hamburg 1529, Wolfenbüttel 1543, Herford 1532, Wittenberg 1533). Wolfenbüttel 1543 dropped even the common Preface as "needless".
- **Saints' days.** Sanctoral Prefaces were excluded as impure. The exceptions are:
  - **Michaelmas**, with the common Preface (Hoya, Osnabrück, Lippe);
  - the **Marian and Apostles' Prefaces** in Dortmund's Low German set of 1554, the Apostles' made to speak of the apostles' "doctrine";
  - Müntzer's rewording (Radical Reformation) of the Marian Preface for Advent.
- **Who sang.** The priest sang the Preface at the altar; the choir answered and sang the Sanctus.
- **Language.** In Lippe 1571 and Mecklenburg the towns had Latin and the villages German.

8. The communion chant was optional from the start and was mostly replaced by hymns (§4.9).

- **Optional.** Luther says "If one will sing the communion, let it be sung".
- **Kept in Latin.** Volprecht, Ansbach 1536 and Brandenburg 1540 kept it.
- **German.** Müntzer (Radical Reformation) and Erfurt translated it.
- **Polyphony.** In the larger churches festal motets "*sub communione*" (during the communion) took its place, among them Clemens non Papa's *Pascha nostrum* (Christ our passover) at Hof.

9. The old melodies were kept, trimmed, and supplemented (§4.10).

- **Kept.** The Latin propers kept the plainchant of the old books, standardized in **Lossius's *Psalmodia***. Rostock made it binding around 1560, and Hof used it in 1592.
- **Trimmed.** They were trimmed by verse and melisma.
- **New tones.** German texts got new or adapted tones.
- **Polyphony.** From the 1530s the feasts brought **polyphonic** introits, Masses and motets: "choraliter or figuraliter". Hof 1592 names Senfl, Lassus, Clemens, Victoria, Walter, Isaac and Josquin.
- **Organ.** The organ alternated with the choir in the introit and the ordinary.

10. Appendix 4.A gives every Proper Preface in the corpus.

- **Latin.** The Latin set (Christmas, Epiphany, Easter, Ascension, Pentecost, Trinity, common) belongs to the Lower Saxon and Westphalian orders, Lüneburg 1564 to Verden 1606.
- **German translations of the Latin:**
  - **Müntzer's** (1524, Radical Reformation), carried on by Erfurt, Calenberg-Göttingen and the Lippe villages;
  - **Strasbourg's** (1524, Moderate Reformed);
  - **Dortmund's** Low German (1554), which alone translates the whole Roman series, Lent, Cross, the Virgin and the Apostles included.
- **New German Prefaces.** There are four:
  - Grubenhagen's Isaiah 53 Preface for Maundy Thursday (1581);
  - Lippe's Michaelmas Preface on the forgiveness of sins (1571);
  - Kurland's Christmas and Pentecost Prefaces (1570), built on the Easter Preface.

4.2 Scope, sources and cautions

What was searched. The `eko.db` database was searched for every proper by name, in Latin, German and Low German spellings:

- *introitus* (introit);
- *prophetia* (prophecy), *lectio* (lesson);
- *epistola* (epistle);
- *graduale* (gradual), *alleluia*, *tractus* (tract);
- *evangelium* (gospel);
- *offertorium* (offertory);
- *praefatio* (preface), *Vorrede* (preface);
- *communio*, *sub communione* (during the communion).

It was also searched for the singers (*Schüler*, *Knaben*, *Chor*, *Cantor*, *Organist*), for the languages (*lateinisch*, *deutsch*, *düdesch*), and for the music (*Noten*, *Ton*, *tonus*, *Melodei*, *figuraliter*, *choraliter*, *mensur*). The Proper Prefaces were searched for by the opening words of each Latin text and of the known German translations. The passages were then read in context.

Related chapters. Two earlier chapters overlap with this one:

- Chapter 8 deals with the **hymns** that replaced the introit, gradual, sequence, offertory and communion. This chapter deals with the propers themselves: the Latin chant, German prose versions, and the lessons and Prefaces.
- Chapter 7 gives the German **common** Prefaces of the early German Masses (Kantz, Worms (Moderate Reformed), Volprecht, Döber, Bremen) and the Preface sections of Müntzer (Radical Reformation), Strasbourg (Moderate Reformed), the Kiel Mass and Lippe. Those texts are cited here, not repeated, except where a Proper Preface is concerned.

Later chapters take up related subjects:

- Chapter 5 covers the collect, the secret and the postcommunion (§§5.4–5.6).
- Chapter 2 covers the place of the propers in the order of the Mass, and the Preface as part of the ordinary (§§2.5, 2.10).
- Chapter 12 covers the feasts whose propers were kept, and the proper prefaces and sequences as marks of rank (§§12.8, 12.10.3–12.10.4).
- Chapter 9 covers the organ in alternation (§9.3.3).
- Chapter 11 covers preaching on the lessons (§11.5).

Cautions. Four things limit what the corpus can show:

- **Silence is not absence.** Many orders say only "the introit" or "the gradual", or "as hitherto", and assume the old books. Where an order is silent, the Latin chant may well have gone on.
- **Sehling did not print everything.** The edition leaves out much musical and liturgical matter. The notated Prefaces of Mecklenburg (1545, 1552), Pomerania (1542), Mansfeld (1580) and Buxtehude (1565) are described but not printed (Appendix 4.A, introduction). Hof's tables of introits and motets are printed, but its notes are not.
- **Notes are marked, not reproduced.** Where an order prints music, the edition shows "[Noten:]" (Notes:) and "[Ende der Noten]" (End of the notes). The texts are given, but not the melodies. Sehling's editors often identify the melody in the *Handbuch der deutschen evangelischen Kirchenmusik* (Handbook of German Evangelical Church Music).
- **Town and village differ.** A territorial order often sets one practice for the towns with Latin schools and another for the villages. Both are reported here.

Terms.

- ***de tempore***: of the season, or of the Sunday.
- ***de sanctis***: of the saints.
- ***dominica***: of the Sunday.
- ***de festo***: of the feast.
- ***choraliter***: in plainchant.
- ***figuraliter***, ***in mensuris***, "mensur": in mensural polyphony.
- ***organicen***: the organist.
- ***Schüler***, ***Knaben***, ***Chor***: the Latin school, which was the choir.
- ***Amt***: the Mass, "the office".

4.3 Three ways of handling the propers

The orders deal with the propers in one of three ways, and many combine them by place and by day:

- **keep them in Latin**, sung by the school (§4.3.1);
- **translate them into German prose**, sung to the old tones (§4.3.2);
- **replace them with German hymns** sung by the congregation (§4.3.3).

4.3.1 Latin propers, sung by the school (the *Formula missae* line)

Luther's position. Luther's *Formula missae* (1523) keeps the sung propers of the Sundays and the feasts of Christ:

- the introit (§4.4.1);
- the gradual of two verses with the alleluia (§4.6.1);
- the communion "if one will" (§4.9.1).

It rejects the offertory as the beginning of the "abomination" of the sacrifice (§4.7.1). The rule is that what is sung *de tempore* (of the season), from Scripture, may stay. Luther says the Sunday propers "alone still bear witness to the ancient purity, except the canon" (Sehling 1, p. 4).

Wittenberg 1525. A Wittenberg report of 1525 on "how it is held for a time with the ceremonies of the Mass" lists the parts sung. They include, at that date, even the offertory. **Wittenberg, *Wie es einer zeit mit den ceremonien der messe gehalten*, 1525** (Sehling 1, p. 698):

[…] yet for certain causes touching the faith one letteth sing *de tempore*, and not *de sanctis* (of the saints); and one singeth the introit, Kyrie eleison, Gloria in excelsis, Et in terra, the collect or prayers, the epistle, the graduals (without sequence), the gospel, the Creed, the offertory, the preface, the Sanctus; without the greater and lesser canon, since these are not agreeable to Scripture.

Who sang the Latin propers. In the orders that kept the Latin propers, they were sung by the **school choir** under the cantor or schoolmaster: the introit, gradual, alleluia, sometimes the offertory, and the communion. The priest sang the collect, epistle, gospel and Preface. Latin was defended as **training for the boys**. Veit Dietrich's Nürnberg *Agendbüchlein* (1545) has the scholars sing the introit "if it be agreeable to Scripture, or a German psalm". It adds that "where there are schools, the Latin tongue also be exercised with singing in the church". **Nürnberg, *Agendbüchlein* of Veit Dietrich, 1545** (Sehling 11, p. 495):

Meanwhile shall the scholars sing the introit, if it be agreeable to scripture, or a German psalm, according as it is in use; yet so that, where there are schools, the Latin tongue be also exercised with singing in the church.

The territorial orders. The Latin propers were kept in this way in the territorial orders of Albertine Saxony (1539, 1580), Brandenburg (1540), Brandenburg-Nürnberg (1533), Pfalz-Neuburg (1543), Mecklenburg (1545, 1552), Pomerania (1535, 1542, 1569), Hohenlohe (1553), Amberg (1550, 1555), Regensburg (1553, 1567), Hamburg (1556), Wolfenbüttel (1543, 1569), Lüneburg (1564), Hoya and Grubenhagen (1581) and Hof (1592). Each has its own limits, given in the sections that follow.

Brandenburg 1540 is the most conservative. It keeps the Latin offertory and communion as well, in the collegiate churches and towns. The parishes and villages get German psalms (§4.7.2).

4.3.2 German prose propers, sung to the old tones

Müntzer (Radical Reformation). Müntzer's *Deutsch evangelisch Messe* (German Evangelical Mass; Allstedt 1524) is the first full set. For each of five offices (Advent, Christmas, Passion, Easter, Pentecost) it has a German introit with its whole psalm, Kyrie, Gloria, collect, epistle, gradual and alleluia, gospel, offertory, Preface, Sanctus, Agnus Dei and communion. It is printed with notes. Müntzer's own explanation says the people are "led with the customary singing, in their own tongue, as children are brought up with milk". **Allstedt, Thomas Müntzer, *Ordnung und berechnunge des teutschen ampts*, 1523/24** (Radical Reformation; Sehling 1, pp. 504–505):

Accordingly with us the entrance of the mystery of God is taken out of the Psalter, where the key of David is on the shoulder of Christ, to open all that is sung. That it may be seen clearly, without piecework, the whole psalm is sung, as was done in the beginning of Christendom by the godly followers of the holy apostles. […] After this the gradual and alleluia are sung, that a man may be heartened to rely firmly on God's word. […] Secondly, be it known that we always read a whole chapter instead of the epistle and gospel, that the piecemeal manner may thereby be cast off, and the holy scripture of the Bible be made common to the people, […] and the people be led with the customary singing, in their own tongue, as children are brought up with milk […]

Erfurt and Calenberg. The **Erfurt *Deutsches Kirchenamt*** (1525) reprints Müntzer's offices, labels each piece (*Introitus*, *Gradual*, *Offertorium*, *Prefatio*, *Commun.*) and adds one for Trinity (Sehling 2, pp. 376–380). **Calenberg-Göttingen 1542** gives a notated German Mass for the Sundays and the feasts with German epistles, gospels, alleluias and Prefaces, but it has a German psalm "in place of the offertory" (Sehling 6/2, pp. 813–833). Sehling's editors trace its Prefaces to Müntzer and to the Erfurt *Kirchenamt*.

Strasbourg 1524 (Moderate Reformed). The **Strasbourg *Teutsche Meß*** of 1524 gives German Prefaces for the feasts (Sehling 20/1, pp. 133–134). Its Augsburg reprint explains each Latin heading for the reader: "Introitus: that is called the beginning or entrance" (p. 135). Its successors drop the Preface (§4.8.1).

Later German prose propers. These are fewer:

- Wittgenstein 1555 lets the festal introits be "learned and sung in German in the villages" (§4.4.4).
- Hof 1592 has German prose introits for ordinary Sundays (§4.4.4).
- The German Prefaces of Lippe 1571, Kurland 1570 and Grubenhagen 1581 are given in Appendix 4.A.

4.3.3 Hymns in place of the propers (the *Deutsche Messe* line)

Luther's *Deutsche Messe* (1526) replaces the introit with "a spiritual song or a German psalm", and the gradual with a German hymn ("Nu bitten wir" or another). It has no offertory and no Preface. It keeps the epistle and gospel, sung in German to new

tones (§4.5.3). This model, and the choice of hymns, is the subject of the hymn-practice chapter (Chapter 8, §§8.3–8.5, 8.8, 8.11, 8.14). Here it matters only as the third option, which most orders allowed side by side with the first:

- "**in the towns** Latin, **in the villages** German";
- "**where there is a school**" Latin, otherwise a German psalm;
- Latin "**on the feasts**", German on ordinary Sundays.

Albertine Saxony. Duke Henry's Saxon order of 1539 makes the arrangement for ordinary use. **Albertine Saxony, *Kirchenordnunge zum anfang* (Duke Henry's *Agende*), 1539** (Sehling 1, p. 271):

[…] the scholars shall sing: first the introit of the Sunday or of the feast, thereafter the Kyrie eleison, Gloria in excelsis and Et in terra in Latin; thereafter the collects in German or Latin; thereafter the epistle toward the people in German; thereafter a sequence, or a German psalm, or other spiritual song, as each season requireth. Thereafter the gospel of the Sunday or of the feast, also read toward the people in German; thereupon the Creed sung, "Wir glauben all an einen Gott" (We all believe in one God) etc.

4.4 The introit

4.4.1 Luther's rule: the Sunday and festal introits, if from Scripture

The *Formula missae* (Form of the Mass) approves "the introits of the Sundays and of the feasts of Christ", Easter, Pentecost and Christmas, though Luther would rather have the whole psalms "from which they are taken, as of old". Introits of the saints may be kept by those who wish, "when they are taken from the psalms or other Scriptures". **Luther, *Formula missae et communionis*, 1523** (Sehling 1, p. 5):

First, the introits of the Sundays and of the feasts of Christ, to wit of Easter, Pentecost and the Nativity, we approve and keep; although we had rather have the psalms, whence they are taken, as of old; but now we will indulge the received use. But if any will approve the introits of the apostles, of the Virgin and of other saints (when they are taken out of the psalms or other scriptures), we condemn it not.

The rest of the century repeats the condition "if it be taken from Holy Scripture" or "so far as it is pure" almost word for word:

- Brandenburg-Nürnberg 1533 (Sehling 11, p. 188);
- Weißenburg 1528 (11, p. 659);
- Hohenlohe 1553 (15, p. 68);
- Mecklenburg 1545 (5, p. 151);
- Teschen 1584 (3, p. 462);
- Henneberg (Meiningen) 1566 (2, p. 339).

4.4.2 Who sang it: the school, in Latin, with a German psalm for the villages

The school sang it. The introit was sung by the **school**: the schoolmaster or cantor with the boys, "as was customary". The priest might read it quietly at the altar meanwhile. The Brandenburg-Nürnberg order of 1533 sets out the arrangement that became standard in the south. **Brandenburg-Nürnberg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1533** (Sehling 11, p. 188):

[…] thereafter [let the priest] read the introit, provided it be taken out of holy scripture. Meanwhile let the scholars, where there is a school, sing the introit also in Latin. But where, as in villages, there are no folk for such Latin singing, a christian German song shall be sung, according to the occasion of each place. And where the people could not [sing] such songs, the pastors shall set about teaching them.

Where there was no choir. In Pfalz-Neuburg 1543, "where there is no choir, as in the country in villages", the **priest himself** sings or reads the introit (Sehling 13, p. 70).

Saxony. Duke Henry's Saxon order of 1539 and the Electoral Saxon order of 1580 both open the Mass with "the scholars shall sing: first the introit of the Sunday or feast" (Sehling 1, pp. 271, 368).

The north. The northern orders have the same division. Mecklenburg 1545 has the cantor or schoolmaster "in the towns" begin the introit in Latin, "or sing at times a German psalm". It gives the introits of the chief feasts by incipit. In the villages, between Christmas and Candlemas, the German stanzas of "Ein Kindelein so löbelich" (A little child so praiseworthy) serve as the introit. **Mecklenburg, *Ordeninge der misse*, 1545** (Sehling 5, p. 151):

Hereafter in the towns shall the cantor or schoolmaster begin the introit in Latin, or sing at times a German psalm, "Have mercy upon me, O Lord God", etc. One may through the year in the towns sing the introits that are not against holy scripture. On the high feasts, at Christmas: *Puer natus* etc. On Epiphany: *Ecce advenit* etc. On the Purification let the four goodly verses be sung for an introit, "A little child so laudable" etc.; which also on the Sundays between Christmas and Candlemas shall be sung in the villages for an introit. […] At Easter: *Resurrexi*; at the Ascension: *Viri Galilaei*; at Pentecost: *Spiritus Domini* (The Spirit of the Lord); on Trinity: *Benedicta sit sancta Trinitas* (Blessed be the holy Trinity).

Hesse, late in the century. The Hessian *Agende* of 1574 (Philippist) allows a Latin psalm "or introit" only where there are people who understand it, and only "at the beginning, before the whole congregation cometh together". In the villages German songs only are to be sung, and in the towns German songs for the most part. **Hesse, *Agende*, 1574** (Philippist; Sehling 8, p. 411):

[…] a Latin psalm or introit [may] be sung; yet so that in the villages throughout, but in the towns for the most part, only German songs be and remain in common use.

Sung slowly. Calenberg-Göttingen 1542 has the choir sing the introit "**right slowly, so that it become not an ass's braying**" (Sehling 6/2, p. 793).

4.4.3 The Trinity or Holy Ghost introit as a fallback

Where the boys could not learn a new introit each Sunday, the orders let them repeat one. The usual choices were *Benedicta sit sancta Trinitas* (Trinity) or *Spiritus Domini* (The Spirit of the Lord; Pentecost). Hatzkerode (about 1534) allows the Trinity introit "where the Sunday introits were too hard for the boys". It adds that they "should yet learn them in time, since they are taken from Scripture". **Hatzkerode, *Kirchenordnunge*, 1534(?)** (Sehling 2, p. 586):

[…] thereafter the introit of the feast or of the season, sometimes of the Holy Trinity at the pastor's pleasure, where the Sunday introits were too hard for the boys. Yet they shall learn them also in time, since they are taken out of scripture.

Other orders with the same fallback.

- **Heilbronn's song order of 1543** begins "**Every Sunday hath its own introit, which shall be sung to the organ**". For a schoolmaster who finds that too much, it provides a reduced cycle: from Easter to Pentecost the Easter introit, from Trinity *Benedicta* (Blessed be; Sehling 17/1, p. 322).
- **Kurpfalz 1546** names "the introit of the season, or of the Holy Trinity, or of the Holy Ghost" (Sehling 14, p. 96).
- **Hamburg 1556** keeps the Latin introit for feasts, and "sometimes also on the Sundays *de Trinitate* or *de Spiritu sancto*" (Sehling 5, p. 552).

4.4.4 German introits

Müntzer and Erfurt. Müntzer's *Deutsch evangelisch Messe* (1524, Radical Reformation) and the Lutheran Erfurt *Deutsches Kirchenamt* (1525) translate the introits into German prose, with their psalm verse and *Gloria Patri*, and sing them to the Latin melody (§4.3.2). Erfurt's Christmas introit is an example. **Erfurt, *Deutsches Kirchenamt*, 1525, "the office of the birth of Christ"** (Sehling 2, p. 379):

Introit: Unto us a child is born, and unto us a son is given, whose government is upon his shoulder; and his name shall be called the angel of great counsel. Sing unto God the Lord a new song, for he hath done marvellous things. Glory be to the Father and to the, etc.

Wittgenstein 1555. Wittgenstein keeps the Latin festal introits, *Puer natus*, *Resurrexi* and *Spiritus Domini* (The Spirit of the Lord). It adds that these "may also be learned and sung in German in the villages", or else replaced by the festal hymn. **Wittgenstein, *Kirchenordnung*, 1555** (Sehling 22, p. 102):

[…] after the *Veni sancte* sing the customary introit, such as are: *Puer natus est nobis* (Unto us a child is born) etc., *Resurrexi et adhuc tecum sum* (I am risen and am still with thee) etc., *Spiritus Domini replevit orbem terrarum* (The Spirit of the Lord hath filled

the world) etc.; which one may also learn and sing in German in the villages, or use in their stead: "Der Tag, der ist so freudenreich" (The day that is so full of joy) etc., "Christ lag in Todesbanden" (Christ lay in death's bonds) etc., "Es ist das Heil uns kommen her" (Salvation has come to us) etc.

Hof 1592. Hof's weekly table (§4.10.3) gives German prose introits for ordinary Sundays: "Art thou he that should come?" (Advent III), "Unto us a child is born" (Epiphany I), "I am the resurrection" (Cantate) (Sehling 11, pp. 433–440). The festal introits are kept in Latin, in polyphony.

Hymns in the introit's place. These are treated in the hymn-practice chapter (Chapter 8, §8.5): "a German psalm" (Ps 67, 51, 130, 12, 124 or 14), "Komm heiliger Geist" (Come, Holy Ghost), or the feast's own *Leise* (Leise (a vernacular hymn ending Kyrieleis)).

4.4.5 Organ, polyphony and alternation

Organ. In the larger churches the introit was shared between organ and choir, or set in polyphony:

- In **Regensburg 1553** the organist, if there is one, "plays the introit together with the Kyrie, *Et in terra*, *Patrem*, Sanctus and Agnus Dei on the organ" (Sehling 13, p. 421).
- In **Merseburg 1545**, at an ordination Mass, *Benedicta sit sancta Trinitas* (Blessed be the holy Trinity), the Kyrie and the Gloria were sung "on the organ and choir", in alternation (Sehling 2, p. 7).
- In **Nördlingen 1579**, on the high feasts, "the introit of the season is first struck by the organist, and sung by the scholars *figuraliter*" (Sehling 12, p. 365).

Hof 1592 describes a three-choir alternation of the introit with the organ. The parts are the whole choir, a second choir of the older boys, and a **choir of girls**. **Hof, *Ordo ecclesiasticus*, 1592** (Sehling 11, p. 424):

I. The organist playeth the introit as far as the verse; and the choir, the schoolmaster governing, singeth the same: the first part the whole choir, the second or repetition the second choir, made up of the older [boys], the versicle the choir of girls, which is the third in order. These done, the organist preludeth the versicle or *Gloria Patri*; the whole choir [sings] *Gloria Patri*; the second choir beginneth the introit again as far as the repetition; the girls' choir finisheth the repetition as far as the versicle. […] Note. In figural music the introit is sung in the same manner and once only, the cantor presiding, as far as the versicle; after the organ hath been heard, the versicle alone is added, and nothing more repeated.

Hof's festal table assigns polyphonic introits by name. For Christmas it has "*Puer natus est nobis*, a 4, by Senfl", and for the Ascension "*Viri Galilaei*, a 4" (Sehling 11, pp. 457, 462). See §4.10.

The organ's prelude and its alternation with the choir are treated in Chapter 9, §§9.3.2–9.3.3.

4.5 The lessons: prophecy, epistle and gospel

4.5.1 The Old Testament "prophecy"

At the Mass. None of the orders in the corpus adds a regular **Old Testament lesson** (*prophetia*, *lectio*) before the epistle. The lessons from the prophets that survive are of two kinds:

- **The historic epistles taken from a prophet.** Hof 1592 instructs its readers how to announce them: "The lesson from the prophet Isaiah …", and the like (Sehling 11, p. 409). These are the lessons of the Christmas Masses, Epiphany and the Ember days in the Missal.
- **Festal chapters in place of the epistle.** Pfalz-Neuburg 1543 has "the chapters out of the Bible" read on the feasts "wherein the history of the feast is described" (Sehling 13, p. 71). Mecklenburg 1545 reads Isaiah 40 for St John the Baptist's day, because "it is written of John the Baptist" (Sehling 5, p. 152).

At Matins and Vespers. The Old Testament lessons were read at the office, not the Mass. Their **tone** was the tone of the prophecies. Hamburg 1529 has the lessons read "in the tone in which one is wont to read at Matins; but the ending as one was wont to end when one read a prophecy, thus: *sol sol sol la sol fa fa*" (Sehling 5, p. 522). Pomerania 1535 prescribes the same cadence (Sehling 4, p. 349). Wittenberg 1533 has the boys end each lesson "as one was wont to read or sing the prophecies, *in fine*: *sol sol mi fa sol sol*" (Sehling 1, p. 703). This is one of the few places where an order writes down a melodic formula of the old chant.

4.5.2 The epistle and gospel: kept, and read toward the people

Kept everywhere. Every Lutheran order in the corpus keeps the **epistle and gospel of the day** (*de dominica*, *de festo*), with these exceptions:

- **Müntzer** (Radical Reformation) reads "always a whole chapter instead of the epistle and gospel" (§4.3.2).
- **Nürnberg 1524** and **Brandenburg-Nürnberg 1533** read the New Testament continuously (*lectio continua*). In the Nürnberg parish Mass of 1524 the minister sings a whole chapter of Romans, and the deacon a chapter of Matthew, in German, each with a fixed announcement: "Ye dearly beloved, hear the Nth chapter …" (Sehling 11, p. 46).

Toward the people. The reader turns **toward the people** ("gegen dem volk", "tom volke gekeret"). That is what made the reading a reading. The **priest** reads the epistle and gospel in most orders. Where there were deacons or chaplains, they read: in Pfalz-Neuburg and Regensburg the subdeacon and deacon (see Chapter 16, §16.4.2). Some orders read the epistle **from the pulpit**:

- Schweinfurt 1543: "the chaplain shall not read the epistle over the altar, but from the pulpit" (Sehling 11, p. 641);
- Pomerania 1535: "as one is wont to do on the pulpit" (Sehling 4, p. 341).

Preaching on the Sunday gospels and epistles is treated in Chapter 11, §11.5.1.

4.5.3 Sung or read, Latin or German

Luther's tones. Luther's *Deutsche Messe* (German Mass) sets the **epistle in the eighth tone**, "that it remain at the same pitch as the collect", and the **gospel in the fifth tone**, both "with the face turned to the people". **Luther, *Deutsche Messe und ordnung gottis diensts*, 1526** (Sehling 1, p. 14):

Thereafter the epistle in the eighth tone, that he remain at the same pitch, in unison with the collect; whose rules are these: […] But he shall read the epistle with his face turned to the people, but the collects with his face turned to the altar. […] Thereafter he readeth the gospel in the fifth tone, also with his face turned to the people.

Saxony copies Wittenberg. The Saxon orders refer the pastors to the larger towns for the melody. The visitation instruction of 1539 says: "the melody for singing the gospels and epistles in German the pastors may seek and copy at the churches of the greater towns, as Dresden, Leipzig, Weißenfels, Salza" (Sehling 1, p. 281). Wurzen (1542) and the Saxon town orders want the epistle read "in German, in the tone and accent customary at Wittenberg, Torgau, Dresden or Leipzig" (Sehling 2, p. 98; 1, p. 564).

Read without notes. Other orders had the lessons read **without notes**, for intelligibility:

- Mecklenburg 1545: "with a loud voice, without notes, that the church may understand the words" (Sehling 5, p. 152);
- Mecklenburg 1552 repeats it (5, p. 202);
- Pomerania 1535: "if the priest cannot sing, he may read loud and understandable" (4, p. 341).

Latin first, then German. A third group kept the **Latin chant first**, for the school, and then read the lesson again in German:

- **Schwäbisch Hall** (1526): the deacon sings the gospel "in the choir in this tone, as it hath hitherto been sung", and it is then read to the people in German (Sehling 17/1, p. 40).
- **Hamburg 1556**: two scholars read the Latin gospel "in the customary tone", and a third repeats it in German "in the same tone" (Sehling 5, p. 552).
- **Brieg 1592**: the pastor sings the epistle and the gospel in Latin before the altar, but "in little towns it may remain in German" (Sehling 3, p. 445).
- **Brandenburg 1573**: the electoral visitors went furthest. They required the epistles and gospels to be sung "**not in German, but in the old customary melody in Latin**", then read in German "for the simple folk's sake, that they may understand it, which cannot happen in singing". **Brandenburg, *Visitations- und Consistorialordnung*, 1573** (Sehling 3, p. 129):

They shall also see to it that the pastors and chaplains sing the epistles and gospels before the altar not in German, but in the old customary melody in Latin, and then afterward, for the simple folk's sake, read them in German, that they may understand it, which in singing cannot be done […]

Wittenberg's German tones. Halle's order of 1543 takes the opposite view. It lets the epistles and gospels be sung in Latin "for the youth's sake", "yet it shall also be free to have them sung in German, as at Wittenberg, and especially when one hath a good melody" (Sehling 2, p. 436). **Calenberg-Göttingen 1542** prints its German gospels with notes, to be sung "in German toward the people with a loud voice" (Sehling 6/2, p. 813).

4.6 Gradual, alleluia and tract

4.6.1 Luther: two verses, and the alleluia always

The *Formula missae* (Form of the Mass) keeps "the gradual of two verses together with the alleluia, or either". The long Lenten graduals and tracts are to be sung "by whoever will, in his own house". The alleluia is not to be dropped in Lent, for "**the alleluia is the perpetual voice of the church**". **Luther, *Formula missae et communionis*, 1523** (Sehling 1, p. 5):

Fourthly, let the gradual of two verses, together with the alleluia, or either of them, be sung at the bishop's discretion. But the Lenten graduals and the like, which exceed two verses, let whoso will sing in his own house. In the church we will not have the spirit of the faithful quenched with tedium. […] For the alleluia is the perpetual voice of the church, as the memory of his passion and victory is perpetual.

Schleswig-Holstein and Hildesheim. Bugenhagen's orders for Schleswig-Holstein (1542) and Hildesheim (1544) take this over. They also **shorten the melody**: the children sing the alleluia with its verse, "**but leaving out the many notes which one was wont to hang on at the end**", that is, the jubilus. Before the gradual "a German psalm, taken from Scripture, or else a gradual that hath two verses". **Schleswig-Holstein, *Kirchenordnung*, 1542** (Sehling 23, p. 90):

The alleluia, which is a perpetual voice of the church, the children sing with the verse, yet leaving out the many notes which one was wont to hang on behind; thereafter, for the gradual, a German psalm taken out of Scripture, or else a gradual that hath two verses.

The Hildesheim text is word for word the same (Sehling 7/2.1, p. 853).

4.6.2 Kept where pure, by the school, or exchanged for a German psalm

The pattern. The gradual and alleluia survived as a **choir piece in Latin**, sung by the school between the epistle and gospel. In the parishes and villages they were exchanged for a German psalm or hymn:

- **Brandenburg 1540**: "the gradual, or in the parishes a German psalm in place of the gradual; then the alleluia and sequence, or as occasion serveth a tract, in Latin" (Sehling 3, p. 71).
- **Pfalz-Neuburg 1543**: the choir "sings again in Latin a gradual or a tract or an alleluia with a sequence, as the order of the season giveth". "Where there is no choir, the priest may sing or say it himself, and the people meanwhile a good German spiritual song" (Sehling 13, p. 71).
- **Brandenburg-Nürnberg 1533**: the priest "may read an alleluia with its verse in Latin, or a gradual taken from holy Scripture; the same the scholars may also sing in Latin" (Sehling 11, p. 195).
- **Weißenburg 1528**: "the schoolmaster sings a short alleluia or gradual" (Sehling 11, p. 659).

Where the gradual was not pure. The Ansbach *Auctuarium* of 1548, an Interim order, lists German psalms to be sung where the gradual or alleluia "were not pure, as commonly *de sanctis*". **Brandenburg-Ansbach-Kulmbach, *Auctuarium*, 1548** (Interim order; Sehling 11, p. 329):

On the other holy days and feasts which have no sequence, or none pure, one shall sing the gradual or alleluia. But where these were not pure, as commonly *de sanctis* (of the saints), let one of these psalms be sung in their stead: "Ein feste Burg ist unser Gott" (A mighty fortress is our God) etc., "Wär Gott nicht mit uns diese Zeit" (Were God not with us at this time) etc., "Wohl dem, der in Gottes Furcht steht" (Blessed is he who stands in the fear of God) etc., "Aus tiefer Not" (Out of deep distress) etc.

The tract. The tract, the Lenten substitute for the alleluia, appears in Brandenburg 1540, Pfalz-Neuburg 1543, Pomerania 1569 and Hof 1592. Luther's ruling notwithstanding, these orders kept the Lenten change.

4.6.3 German graduals

Müntzer and Erfurt. These (Müntzer's Radical Reformation offices and Erfurt's Lutheran reprint) have German prose graduals and alleluias. Erfurt's Passion gradual is an example. **Erfurt, *Deutsches Kirchenamt*, 1525, office of the Passion** (Sehling 2, p. 380):

Gradual: Christ became for us obedient unto death, even the death of the cross. Wherefore God also hath exalted him, and given him a name which is above every name. Alleluia: Alleluia. Christ became obedient to his Father unto death, even the death of the cross.

This is *Christus factus est* (Christ became [obedient]), the gradual of Maundy Thursday and Palm Sunday, in German.

Nürnberg's new tone. In Nürnberg, by the report sent to Goslar in 1528, "the gradual is sung, that is again a verse or two from the Psalter or another book of the Old Testament, **in a tone made for it**". The tone was new, not the old melisma (Sehling 7/2.2, p. 230).

Calenberg-Göttingen. The German alleluias of Calenberg-Göttingen 1542 are printed with notes. For the Purification it puts the *Nunc dimittis* hymn "Mit fried und freud ich far dahin" (With peace and joy I depart) "for the gradual and alleluia" (Sehling 6/2, pp. 813, 823).

4.6.4 The sequence

The sequence, the hymn after the alleluia, was cut back to a few "pure" texts for the chief feasts and farced with German stanzas. This is treated in Chapter 8, §8.8.2–8.8.3.

The sequences as marks of the great feasts are treated in Chapter 12, §12.10.4.

4.7 The offertory

4.7.1 Rejected with the offertory prayers

For Luther the offertory chant belonged to "that whole abomination" that begins at the offertory, where "almost everything soundeth and smelleth of oblation" (Sehling 1, p. 5). Most orders dropped the chant together with the offertory prayers (the *canon minor* [lesser canon]):

- **Volprecht's Nürnberg Mass (1524)**: "The offertory is never said, **because Christ was once offered for our sins**" (Sehling 11, p. 39).
- **The Nürnberg parish Mass (1524)**: it is left out with the *canon minor* (Sehling 11, p. 47).
- **Prussia 1525**: "the offertory, secret, *canon minor* and *maior* are necessarily left out" (Sehling 4, p. 32).

Nürnberg, *Deutsche Messe* of Prior Volprecht, 1524 (Sehling 11, p. 39):

The Creed is always said. Meanwhile the chalice is prepared. The offertory is never said, because Christ was once offered for our sins.

4.7.2 Kept as a sung text from Scripture

The Latin offertory kept. A few orders kept the **Latin offertory chant** as a text from Scripture, sung by the choir while the bread and wine were prepared:

- **Wittenberg 1525** lists it among the parts sung (§4.3.1).
- **Brandenburg 1540** has "the offertory of the Sunday or feast" after the sermon, "but in the villages one may sing a German psalm for it" (Sehling 3, p. 71).
- **Amberg 1550**: "Choir: Offertory of the season" (Sehling 13, p. 286).
- **The Ansbach *Auctuarium* (1548)**, an Interim order, has the schoolmaster sing "the Latin offertory **noted in the same Mass, since they are all taken from holy Scripture**", or a Latin responsory. **Brandenburg-Ansbach-Kulmbach, *Auctuarium*, 1548** (Interim order; Sehling 11, p. 330):

As soon as the sermon hath its end, the schoolmaster shall sing the Latin offertory that is noted in the same Mass (for they are all taken out of holy scripture), or else a Latin responsory [...]

German offertories. Müntzer (Radical Reformation) and the Erfurt *Kirchenamt* translate the offertory into German. Erfurt has an offertory for Easter ("The earth trembled and was still, when God arose to judgement. Alleluia", *Terra tremuit* [The earth trembled]) and for Pentecost (*Confirma hoc, Deus*). In the Trinity office it has "a psalm or else a spiritual hymn of praise" "for the offertory" (Sehling 2, pp. 376–378).

4.7.3 A German psalm, or the Creed, in its place

The usual Lutheran solution. The usual Lutheran solution was a German psalm or hymn "in place of the offertory", sung while the elements were prepared and the communicants came forward:

- **Naumburg 1527**: "Aus tiefer Not" (Out of deep distress; Sehling 2, p. 60).
- **Calenberg-Göttingen 1542**: "In place of the offertory one shall sing with the congregation a German psalm", and at Christmas "Ein kindelein so löbelich" (A little child so praiseworthy; Sehling 6/2, pp. 814, 821).
- **Dortmund 1554**: "a fitting hymn of praise for the offertory" (Sehling 21, p. 209).
- **Lippe 1525**: "for the offertory one singeth a spiritual song, that is a psalm" (Sehling 22, p. 568).
- **In Bugenhagen's orders** the creed hymn "Wir glauben all" (We all believe) after the sermon served as the offertory (Chapter 8, §8.9.2, §8.11.3).

4.8 The Proper Preface

The full texts of every Proper Preface in the corpus are in Appendix 4.A. This section deals with three questions:

- whether the Preface was kept at all;
- on which days a proper Preface was used, and which;
- who sang it, in which language and to which tune.

The Preface in the order of the Mass, required, optional or festal, is treated in Chapter 2, §2.10.1, and the proper prefaces as marks of a feast's rank in Chapter 12, §12.10.3.

4.8.1 Kept, shortened or dropped

Luther, 1523. The *Formula missae* (Form of the Mass) keeps the dialogue and the common Preface but **cuts it off at *per Christum Dominum nostrum*** and joins the Words of Institution to it. The Words are sung "in the same tone of voice" as the Preface. Volprecht and the Nürnberg parish Mass of 1524 follow (see Chapter 7, §7.3.2, §7.7.1). The Nürnberg Mass marks the cut with the rubric "Here the preface ends" (Sehling 11, p. 47).

Luther, 1526. The *Deutsche Messe* (German Mass) drops the Preface and puts a paraphrase of the Our Father and an exhortation in its place. Orders that followed the *Deutsche Messe* closely did the same:

- The Prussian order of 1544 says plainly "In place of the preface, **which shall be abolished and left out**", the paraphrase follows. **Prussia, *Kirchenordnung*, 1544** (Sehling 4, p. 65):

In place of the preface, which shall be done away and left out, there followeth straightway a public exhortation and paraphrase of the Our Father, which the priest shall make in conceived or in prescribed words, right loud and audibly [...]

- The Prussian order of 1568 repeats it (Sehling 4, p. 81).
- The Strasbourg agendas after 1525 (Moderate Reformed) have no Preface or Sanctus (Sehling 20/1, p. 63, editor's introduction).
- The Engerhafe liturgy in East Frisia (1583) replaces the Preface with Psalm 111 (Sehling 7/1, p. 677, n. 20).

The compromise of 1539. Duke Henry's Saxon order allowed the exhortation and paraphrase to be dropped "sometimes, especially on the feasts", and the Latin Preface sung instead. **Albertine Saxony, *Kirchenordnunge zum anfang* (Duke Henry's *Agende*), 1539** (Sehling 1, p. 271):

One may also at times, especially on the feasts, forgo reading the paraphrase and exhortation to the people, and instead thereof sing the Latin preface, and thereupon the Latin Sanctus [...]

The usual Lutheran rule. This became the usual Lutheran rule: **Preface on feasts, exhortation on ordinary Sundays**, or Preface "if time allows". Examples:

- Hatzkerode about 1534: "on the great feasts the *praefatio de festo* shall be sung in its stead, with the customary Latin Sanctus" (Sehling 2, p. 587).
- Halberstadt: "On the high feasts the pastor singeth the preface" (Sehling 2, p. 484).
- Pomerania 1535 and 1542: "not always, but when one will, especially at the high feasts" (Sehling 4, pp. 341, 357).
- Mecklenburg 1552: "if the time allows" (Sehling 5, p. 199).
- Lüneburg 1564: "in feasts, in the towns" (Sehling 6/1, p. 546).
- Stralsund 1555: "which may also at times be left out, as the time requireth" (Sehling 4, p. 551).

Shortened at the cantor's discretion. Hamburg 1556 allows the Preface to be shortened, "but so that the cantor and the priest have agreed on it beforehand". **Hamburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1556** (Sehling 5, p. 552):

[…] thereafter sing the preface in Latin, turned to the altar. The preface may also well at times be shortened, but so that the cantor and the priest be agreed beforehand of the case. The Sanctus shall always be sung after it, according to the feasts and Sundays, sometimes in German, "Isaiah the prophet", etc.

4.8.2 Which days: the temporal cycle

The core set. Where a proper Preface was kept, the core set was the *de tempore* (of the season) Prefaces of the feasts of Christ: Christmas, Epiphany, Easter, Ascension, Pentecost and Trinity, with the common Preface for other days. The second Saxon visitation instruction of 1539 names exactly this set, to be taken "out of the Latin missals". **Albertine Saxony, *Instruktion zur zweiten Visitation*, 1539** (Sehling 1, p. 281):

The preface in the mass, or communion: the preface on the Lord's Nativity, the preface on the Lord's Epiphany, the preface on the feast of Easter, the preface on the feast of the Lord's Ascension, the preface on the feast of Pentecost, the preface of the Holy Trinity. Item the common preface, the pastors may take out of the Latin missals […]

Shorter sets. Some orders used fewer:

- **Lippe 1571** prints only Christmas, Easter, Pentecost and Michaelmas, for "the high four-times feasts" (*Viergezeiten*) (Sehling 21, p. 410).
- **Grubenhagen 1581** has Christmas, Easter, Pentecost and Trinity, "where there are schools and boys" (Sehling 6/2, p. 1073).
- **Osnabrück 1618** has Michaelmas, Christmas, Easter and Pentecost (Sehling 7/1, pp. 268–269).
- **Kurland 1570** has German Prefaces for Christmas, Easter and Pentecost, sung "for variation" on the high feasts instead of the daily one (§4.A.14).

Two forms for each feast. The Pfalz-Neuburg order (in its 1547 form) says that each high feast has two Prefaces, "**a *solemnis* and a *dominicalis***". These are the solemn and the Sunday tones of the Missal. It tells the priest to write them out with their notes and keep them on the desk. **Pfalz-Neuburg, *Kirchenordnung* of Ottheinrich, [1547]** (Sehling 14, p. 109):

[…] and sing or read the preface, whole or a piece thereof, as occasion serveth. But for certain high feasts, Easter, Ascension, Pentecost, Trinity etc., there are special prefaces, of each feast two, a solemn and a Sunday one, which a priest may note out or write out and have always on the desk beside the church order […]

Trinity on ordinary Sundays. For ordinary Sundays the northern Bugenhagen orders chose the **Trinity Preface**, because it "was made against the Arians", "as the Nicene Creed also was". **Hamburg, *Hamburger Kirchenordnung*, 1529** (Sehling 5, p. 528):

[…] and on the great feasts which have a special preface, and otherwise when he will on certain Sundays with the preface of the Trinity, which was made against the Arians, as was also the Nicene Creed, he shall begin in Latin the preface *Dominus vobiscum* (The Lord be with you), and sing it unto the end. Thereupon let the choir sing a Latin Sanctus.

Wolfenbüttel 1543 gives the same reason, and goes further. It allows Latin Prefaces in the towns at Christmas, Easter and Pentecost, and on other feasts the Trinity Preface. Every other Preface, **the common one included**, is to be "simply let lie as unneeded". **Wolfenbüttel, *Christlike kerken-ordeninge im lande Brunschwig*, 1543** (Sehling 6/1, p. 59):

[…] the priest may then also well sing there the Latin preface of the feast of Christmas, of Easter and of Pentecost, and on other feasts the preface of the Holy Trinity, if one will, which preface was made against the Arians; other prefaces, the *quotidiana* too, let them simply lie as needless, etc. Upon the Latin preface the whole church may joyfully sing the German Sanctus.

Herford (1532) has the rule that a feast takes its own Preface, and a Sunday, if any, the Trinity: "if one will also keep Prefaces on the Sundays, one shall sing the Preface of the Trinity" (Sehling 21, p. 176). So does Wittenberg's own town order of 1533: "on the feasts … with the preface of the feast, or else on the Sunday with the preface *de sancta trinitate*, if one will" (Sehling 1, p. 704).

Calenberg-Göttingen 1542 gives its model Sunday Mass a shortened German **Easter** Preface instead (§4.A.6, German 5).

The seasons are almost absent. No order in the corpus prescribes a Preface for **Advent** apart from Müntzer's tradition (Müntzer himself belongs to the Radical Reformation). That tradition uses the reworded Marian Preface (§4.A.10). Lent and Passiontide have a Preface only in Dortmund and in the Müntzer tradition (§4.A.4–4.A.5). Grubenhagen added a new German Passion Preface from Isaiah 53 for Maundy Thursday (§4.A.12).

4.8.3 Saints' days: Michaelmas, the Virgin and the Apostles

The purity rule. Saints' Prefaces were generally excluded under the rule that only "pure" texts may be sung:

- Halle 1543: "at great feasts the Latin prefaces remain, **which are Christian and agreeable to Scripture**" (Sehling 2, p. 436).
- Corvinus's order for Lippe (1542): "the prefaces **that are pure**" (Sehling 21, p. 345).

The exceptions are few:

- **Michaelmas.** The common Preface is the festal Preface for Michaelmas in Hoya 1581, Osnabrück 1618 and Lippe 1571. Lippe's German version for the villages replaces the choirs of angels with the forgiveness of sins (§4.A.1, §4.A.13). Osnabrück sings it "on Michaelmas **and other high feasts**".
- **The Virgin and the Apostles.** Dortmund 1554 alone translates the Marian Preface, for five feasts including the Assumption, and the Preface of the Apostles. It turns the Apostles' protection into the Apostles' "doctrine" (§4.A.10–4.A.11).
- **Müntzer's tradition** (Müntzer himself Radical Reformation) keeps the Marian Preface's text but strikes Mary's feast from it, and uses it for Advent and Trinity (§4.A.10).

4.8.4 Who sang it, in what language, to which tune

The celebrant sings, the choir answers. Everywhere the Preface belongs to the **priest at the altar**, turned to the altar (Hamburg 1556). The **choir** (the school) answers the dialogue and sings the Sanctus. Kurland 1570 and Osnabrück 1618 mark the parts "Der diener" (The minister) / "Das chor" (The choir) and "Minister" / "Chorus" (Choir; §4.A.14; Sehling 7/1, p. 268). In Osnabrück the Sanctus that follows "is sung or played on the organ" (Sehling 7/1, p. 269). In Wolfenbüttel 1543 "the whole church" sings a German Sanctus to the Latin Preface (above).

Latin in the towns, German in the villages. Language followed the school:

- Mecklenburg's Mass order of 1545 has the pastor sing the Preface in Latin or German in the towns, "in the villages German".
- It also insists on one tune: "these notes and no other", against "the useless motley singing that every man maketh after his own head". **Mecklenburg, *Ordeninge der misse*, 1545** (Sehling 5, p. 154):

[…] the pastor may in the towns at times sing the preface, in Latin or in German, as here followeth. In the villages one shall sing it in German, and especially on the feasts not let it stand over. [The preface] of the Trinity also at times in German. […] The pastors will also learn these notes, as hereafter written; and sing the prefaces and also the words of consecration with these and no other notes. The useless motley singing which every man maketh after his own head edifieth not in the congregation.

- **Lippe 1571** prints each Latin Preface with a German one beside it "for the villages" (§4.A.2, §4.A.6, §4.A.8, §4.A.13).
- **Grubenhagen 1581** keeps the Latin Prefaces only "where there are schools and boys", and gives its new German Isaiah Preface "for the simple layman" (§4.A.12).

- **Kurland 1570** begins the communion "with the customary noted German preface", "since the Latin Mass is abolished" (Sehling 5, p. 89).

The tunes. The Latin Prefaces kept their **Missal tones**:

- Duke Henry's order of 1539 refers the pastors to "the notes of the Latin Missal". Sehling's editor gives this from the first edition (Sehling 1, p. 89).
- The 1539 instruction tells pastors to take the Prefaces "out of the Latin missals" (above).
- Amberg 1555/57 wants them sung "German or Latin, as they are in use in other evangelical places and set to the customary notes" (Sehling 13, p. 291).
- The Pfalz-Neuburg order distinguishes the solemn tone from the Sunday tone (above).
- Hof 1592 has the Preface sung on the chief feasts "from Lossius's book", that is the *Psalmodia* of Lucas Lossius (Sehling 11, p. 473).
- Sehling's editors identify the notated Prefaces of Calenberg-Göttingen, Grubenhagen and the other Lower Saxon orders with the standard melodies in the *Handbuch der deutschen evangelischen Kirchenmusik* (Handbook of German Evangelical Church Music).

The German Prefaces were sung to the same **Preface tone** adapted to German. So were the Words of Institution. Prussia 1544 has them sung "*in nota prefationis*, as they were also sung with us before in that way" (Sehling 4, p. 65).

4.9 The communion chant (*communio*)

4.9.1 Optional, and soon replaced

Luther. The *Formula missae* (Form of the Mass) leaves the communion chant free: "**if one will sing the communion, let it be sung**". The Agnus Dei is sung during the communion itself (Sehling 1, p. 6). **Luther, *Formula missae et communionis*, 1523** (Sehling 1, p. 6):

VI. Then let him communicate both himself and the people; meanwhile let the Agnus Dei be sung. […] VII. If it please to sing the communion, let it be sung.

Orders that kept the Latin communio.

- **Volprecht** (1524): "the communion of whatever Mass is being said" (Sehling 11, p. 39).
- **The Ansbach visitation order of 1536**: "where there are Latin schools", "the introit, Kyrie, Gloria, *Et in terra*, *Patrem*, Sanctus, Agnus Dei **and communion** in Latin" (Sehling 11, p. 326).
- **Brandenburg 1540**: "the Latin preface, the Sanctus, the communion, and further the conclusion" (Sehling 3, p. 71).

German communio. Müntzer (Radical Reformation) and the Erfurt *Kirchenamt* have a German communio for each office. For Easter it is "Our Easter lamb Christ is offered for us. Alleluia" (*Pascha nostrum*). For Christmas it is "All the ends of the earth have seen the Saviour of our God" (*Viderunt omnes*) (Sehling 2, pp. 376, 379). In the Advent office "a psalm or other spiritual hymn of praise" is sung "for the communion" (Sehling 2, p. 379).

Replaced by hymns. Elsewhere the slot was filled by the **communion hymns** and the **Agnus Dei**, often several in turn "according as the communicants be many or few". These are treated in Chapter 8, §8.14–8.15.

4.9.2 Polyphonic communions and festal motets

Motets "sub communione". In the larger town churches the communion was covered by **motets**, Latin and German, often chosen to fit the feast:

- **Wittenberg 1533**: "*Pange lingua* in Latin and the like, and also German songs of the feast, until the communion is over" (Sehling 1, p. 705).
- **Nördlingen 1555**: on Maundy Thursday "*sub communione*, *Pange lingua* in mensural music". At Pentecost the *Sanctus paschale* may be sung "in place of 'Jesaia' and 'Jesus Christus'" (Sehling 12, pp. 321, 325).
- **Hof 1592**: the fullest list. For each Sunday and feast it names a motet "*sub communione*" (during the communion). For the Sunday after Easter (*Quasimodogeniti*) it gives "*Pascha nostrum immolatus est Christus* (Christ our passover is sacrificed), a

5, Clemens non Papa", which is the text of the Easter communio, in polyphony. "If these do not suffice, as also at other times whenever the number of communicants requireth it", it adds "Schaff in mir, Gott, ein reines Herz" (Create in me, O God, a clean heart), a 6, by Leonhard Schröter, or *O sacrum convivium* (O sacred banquet), a 6, by Victoria. **Hof, *Ordo ecclesiasticus*, 1592, Dominica Quasimodogeniti** (Sehling 11, pp. 461–462):

During the communion: *Pascha nostrum immolatus est Christus* (Christ our passover is sacrificed), for five voices, by Clemens non Papa; also *Dum transisset sabbatum* (When the sabbath was past), by Vaet, for six voices. If these suffice not (as also at other times, as often as the number of the communicants requireth it), there is added "Schaff in mir, Gott, ein reines Herz", for six voices, by Leonhard Schröter, or *O sacrum convivium*, for six voices, by L. de Victoria.

The organ. Several orders let the **organ** play during the communion, or alternate with the hymns:

- Regensburg 1553 (Sehling 13, p. 421);
- the Schönburg lordships (1542), "only on the high feasts" (Sehling 2, p. 171);
- Engerhafe 1583 (Sehling 7/1, p. 681).

4.10 The music: old chant, cut chant, new tones, polyphony and organ

4.10.1 The old melodies kept

Latin propers. Where the Latin propers were kept, they were sung to the **plainchant of the old books**:

- the introits, graduals and alleluias of the Gradual;
- the Prefaces in the Missal tones (§4.8.4).

The orders seldom say so outright, because it went without saying. They speak of "the customary notes", "as hitherto", "as was customary". Two late orders insist on the old melody against innovation:

- **Brandenburg 1573** requires the epistles and gospels "in the old customary melody in Latin" (§4.5.3).
- **Mecklenburg 1545** requires the Prefaces and Verba "with these and no other notes" (§4.8.4).

The Lossius standard. From mid-century the Latin chant was standardized for Lutheran use in **Lucas Lossius's *Psalmodia*** (1553). The Rostock order of about 1560 makes it the norm for all the city's churches. **Rostock, *Conformitas ceremoniarum in singulis templis ecclesiae Rostochiensis*, 1560–1576** (Sehling 5, p. 288):

It is held good and deemed needful that in all churches Lucas Lossius's *Psalmodia* be kept, and that the choir order itself thereafter. After the introit the Kyrie shall be sung and played.

Other references to Lossius. Hof 1592 sings the gradual and sequence "from the great Missal or from Lossius's book", and the festal Prefaces "from Lossius's book" (Sehling 11, p. 473). On the authorized cantionals of Spangenberg and Lossius see Chapter 8, §8.18.6.

4.10.2 The old melodies cut

The orders also trimmed the chant:

- **Graduals:** Luther's rule of **two verses** for the gradual, with the long Lenten graduals sent home (§4.6.1).
- **The alleluia's jubilus:** Bugenhagen's **removal of the long melisma** at the end of the alleluia, "the many notes that one was wont to hang on behind" (§4.6.1).
- **Introit psalm:** Müntzer's (Radical Reformation) **whole psalm** for the introit, against the single verse of the medieval introit (§4.3.2).
- **Pace:** Calenberg-Göttingen's warning that the choir sing "right slowly, that it become not an ass's braying" (§4.4.2).

4.10.3 New tones for German texts

The new tones. German texts needed new tones, or adaptations of the old:

- Luther's epistle tone (eighth mode) and gospel tone (fifth mode) in the *Deutsche Messe* (German Mass) (§4.5.3).

- The Nürnberg gradual "in a tone made for it" (§4.6.3).
- Müntzer's notated German offices (Radical Reformation), sung "with the customary singing, in their own tongue" (§4.3.2).
- The German Prefaces of Calenberg-Göttingen, Grubenhagen and Lippe, set to the Preface tone (Appendix 4.A).

Copying the melodies. The Saxon visitors told pastors to copy the melodies for the German epistles and gospels "at the churches of the greater towns" (§4.5.3). Halle 1543 allows the German lessons "especially when one hath a good melody" (Sehling 2, p. 436).

4.10.4 Polyphony

Feasts in mensural music. From the 1530s the propers of the feasts were often sung **in figural (mensural) music** by the school choir. At Naumburg (1537/38) the cantor may "on the high feasts, when one singeth mensural music", sing "a good Latin motet" for the *Et in terra* (And on earth) or after the epistle, "and sometimes, when there is a goodly introit, the same before the 'Komm heiliger Geist'". **Naumburg, *Kirchen-Ordnung für die St. Wenzelskirche*, 1537/1538** (Sehling 2, p. 71):

[...] on the high feasts, when one singeth in measure, the cantor may well at times, instead of the *Et in terra* etc., and also instead of the psalm which one singeth after the epistle, sing a good Latin motet; and at times, when there is a goodly introit, the same instead of "Komm, heiliger Geist" (Come, Holy Ghost).

"Choraliter or figuraliter". The formula "choraliter or figuraliter" is common in the later orders:

- Gottleuba 1567: "one singeth plainchant and sometimes figural" (Sehling 1, p. 567).
- Penig 1575: "the introit, the Kyries etc., *Et in terra pax* etc. *choraliter*, oftener also *figuraliter*" (Sehling 1, p. 634).
- Schwäbisch Hall 1543/1615: "an introit of the season, the Kyrie eleison, *Gloria in excelsis Deo* etc. sung in Latin, *vel choraliter, vel figuraliter*, as the season giveth occasion" (Sehling 17/1, p. 162).
- Nördlingen 1579: on the high feasts the introit is "sung by the scholars *figuraliter*" (Sehling 12, p. 365).
- Schweinfurt 1576: after the epistle the choir, "if it hath adjutants", sings "something in four or five voices" (Sehling 11, p. 648).

Hof 1592. Hof's *Ordo ecclesiasticus* (Church Order) gives the fullest repertory. For each Sunday and feast it names the polyphonic introit, Mass setting, motets after the epistle and the gospel, a motet "in place of 'Nun bitten wir'", and the motets "*sub communione*" (during the communion). The composers are Senfl, Lassus ("Orlandus"), Clemens non Papa, Vaet, Victoria, Johann Walter, Isaac, Josquin, Galliculus, Dressler, Meiland and others. **Hof, *Ordo ecclesiasticus*, 1592, Christmas Day** (Sehling 11, p. 457):

On the day of the Nativity of Jesus Christ. Introit: *Puer natus est nobis* (Unto us a child is born), for four voices, by Senfl. The Mass upon *Praeter rerum seriem* (Beyond the order of things), for six voices, by Ludwig Daser. After the epistle: *Quem vidistis pastores* (Whom saw ye, shepherds?), for six voices, by L. de Victoria. After the gospel: *Resonet in laudibus* (Let it resound in praises), for five voices, by Orlando. In place of "Nun bitten wir" (Now pray we): *Exultet coelum*, by Orlando, for five voices. During the communion: the Sanctus of the foregoing Mass.

The plain Sundays at Hof. Beside this, Hof's ordinary Sunday table uses **German** introits and chorale Kyries (§4.4.4). The festal Latin polyphony and the German chorale service stand side by side in the same order.

Rhau's collections. Sehling's editors note that Georg Rhau's printed collections of 1539–1545 supplied Lutheran choirs with polyphonic introits, alleluias and sequences (Sehling 7/2.1, p. 1085).

4.10.5 The organ

Organ and choir. The organ entered the propers in alternation with the choir:

- **Heilbronn 1543**: "every Sunday hath its own introit, which shall be sung **to the organ**" (Sehling 17/1, p. 322).
- **Regensburg 1553**: the organist "plays the introit" with the ordinary (Sehling 13, p. 421).
- **Schweinfurt 1576**: the organist begins the introit "which the choir singeth after" (Sehling 11, p. 648).
- **Hof 1592**: the organ plays the introit "as far as the verse" in alternation with three choirs (§4.4.5).
- **Osnabrück 1618**: the Sanctus after the Preface "is sung or played on the organ" (Sehling 7/1, p. 269).

Silent seasons. Hof stops the organ from Advent II until Christmas Eve (Sehling 11, p. 432).

4.11 Table by order

Key.

- **L**: Latin, sung by the school or choir.
- **G**: German prose proper.
- **H**: German hymn or psalm in its place.
- **—**: dropped.
- **?**: not stated.
- "town / village": the order sets different practice.

Order	Vol.	Introit	Epistle and gospel	Gradual, alleluia	Offertory	Preface	Communio	Music
Luther, *Formula missae*, 1523	1	L (Sunday and festal, from Scripture)	L	L (two verses); alleluia always	—	Common, cut at *per Christum* (through Christ)	L "if one will"	Plainchant
Müntzer, Allstedt, 1524 (Radical Reformation)	1	G (whole psalm)	G, whole chapters	G	G	G (Advent, Christmas, Passion, Easter, Pentecost)	G	Notated; "customary singing in own tongue"
Nürnberg parish Mass, 1524	11	L	G, chapters in sequence	L	—	Common, cut	?	Plainchant
Volprecht, Nürnberg, 1524	11	L	?	L	— ("never said")	Common, cut	L (*de quo sit missa*, of whatever Mass is said)	—
Wittenberg report, 1525	1	L	L	L (no sequence)	L	L	?	—
Erfurt *Deutsches Kirchenamt*, 1525	2	G	G	G	G (Easter, Pentecost); H (Trinity)	G (Müntzer's, plus Trinity)	G; H (Advent)	Notated
Strasbourg *Teutsche Meß*, 1524 (Moderate Reformed)	20/1	?	G	?	?	G (Christmas, Epiphany, Easter, Ascension, Pentecost; Cross in Schwarz)	?	—
Luther, *Deutsche Messe*, 1526	1	H	G (8th and 5th tones)	H	—	—	H	New tones
Nürnberg report for Goslar, 1528	7/2.2	L	G (levites)	gradual "in a tone made for it"	—	Common, cut	?	New tone

Order	Vol.	Introit	Epistle and gospel	Gradual, alleluia	Offertory	Preface	Communio	Music
Hamburg, 1529	5	?	?	?	?	L on feasts; Trinity on Sundays	?	Prophecy cadence written out
Herford, 1532	21	?	?	?	?	L on feasts; Trinity on Sundays	?	—
Brandenburg-Nürnberg, 1533	11	L by school / H in villages	G, chapters in sequence	L	—	—	?	—
Wittenberg town order, 1533	1	?	?	L alleluia, at times gradual	?	Feast Preface; Trinity on Sundays	Motets (*Pange lingua*)	Prophecy cadence
Hatzkerode, 1534(?)	2	L; Trinity as fallback	G	?	?	L on great feasts	?	Organ in Kyrie and Gloria
Pomerania, 1535/1542/1569	4	L / H	Epistle tone or read	L where schools; tract	?	L or G on feasts (16 Prefaces, 1542, not printed)	?	Prophecy cadence
Naumburg St Wenzel, 1537/38	2	L "goodly introit" on feasts	?	H	H ("Aus tiefer Not", 1527)	?	?	Mensural motets on high feasts
Albertine Saxony (Duke Henry), 1539	1	L by scholars	G toward the people	H or sequence	—	L on feasts instead of exhortation	?	Missal notes; Wittenberg tones
Brandenburg, 1540	3	L	L in foundations / G in parishes	L / H in parishes; tract	L / H in villages	L (common)	L	—
Schleswig-Holstein, 1542; Hildesheim, 1544	23; 7/2.1	?	G	Alleluia with verse, jubilus cut; gradual of two verses / H	Creed hymn	L Prefaces at feasts	H	Melisma cut
Calenberg-Göttingen, 1542	6/2	L ("slowly")	G sung, notated	G alleluia, notated	H	G (Müntzer's; Sunday Easter form)	H	Notated
Pfalz-Neuburg, 1543 (1547 edn.)	13; 14	L / priest in villages	G; festal chapters	L / priest	Offertory prayer (Osiander)	Solemn and Sunday forms for each feast	?	Two Preface tones

Order	Vol.	Introit	Epistle and gospel	Gradual, alleluia	Offertory	Preface	Communio	Music
Wolfenbüttel, 1543	6/1	L on feasts of Christ	?	?	Creed hymn	L Christmas, Easter, Pentecost; Trinity; not the common	H	German Sanctus by the whole church
Heilbronn song order, 1543	17/1	L to the organ; reduced cycle	?	L alleluia or gradual	?	?	?	Organ alternation
Mecklenburg, 1545/1552	5	L in towns, listed by feast / H in villages	G read "without notes"	H	?	L or G in towns / G in villages (not printed)	?	"These notes and no other"
Nürnberg, Veit Dietrich, 1545	11	L where schools / H	?	L or H	—	—	?	Latin "exercised" for the schools
Ansbach visitation, 1536; *Auctuarium*, 1548	11	L	?	L where pure / H	L (from Scripture)	?	L	—
Amberg, 1550/1555	13	L	Customary tone	?	L *de tempore* (of the season)	L or G on feasts, "customary notes"	?	—
Regensburg, 1553	13	L / organ	G	L or Latin text from the gradual	—	—	Organ with hymns	Organ
Dortmund, 1554	21	?	Read or sung, "after old custom"	H	H	Full Roman set in Low German	?	—
Wittgenstein, 1555	22	L festal / G in villages	?	?	?	?	?	—
Hamburg, 1556	5	L on feasts; Trinity or Holy Ghost on Sundays	L read by scholars, then G	?	?	L, may be shortened by agreement with the cantor	?	—
Lüneburg, 1564	6/1	?	?	?	?	L set (7) on high feasts, in towns	?	Notated

Order	Vol.	Introit	Epistle and gospel	Gradual, alleluia	Offertory	Preface	Communio	Music
Wolfenbüttel, 1569	6/1	?	?	?	?	L set (7)	?	Notated
Kurland, 1570	5	?	?	?	?	G "customary noted" daily; G festal (3)	?	Notated
Lippe, 1571	21	L on feasts of Christ	?	?	?	L in towns / G in villages: Christmas, Easter, Pentecost, Michaelmas	?	Notated
Brandenburg visitation, 1573	3	?	**L "old melody", then G read**	?	?	?	?	Old melody required
Hesse *Agende*, 1574 (Philippist)	8	L only before the people gather; H	?	?	?	?	?	—
Nördlingen, 1579	12	Organ plus scholars *figuraliter* (in figured music) on feasts; H on Sundays	?	?	?	?	?	Polyphony, organ
Grubenhagen, 1581; Hoya, 1581	6/2	L (Hoya: pastor)	?	?	?	L where schools; Michaelmas (Hoya); German Isaiah 53 Preface (Grubenhagen)	?	Notated
Hof, 1592	11	L figural on feasts / G on Sundays; organ and three choirs	L then G	L from the Missal or Lossius; tract	?	L from Lossius on chief feasts	Motets	Senfl, Lassus, Clemens, Victoria
Brieg, 1592	3	L	L sung / G in small towns	L	?	?	?	—
Verden, 1606	7/1	?	?	?	?	L set (7)	?	Notated

Order	Vol.	Introit	Epistle and gospel	Gradual, alleluia	Offertory	Preface	Communio	Music
Osnabrück, (1588) 1618	7/1	?	?	?	?	L: Michaelmas, Christmas, Easter, Pentecost	?	Sanctus by organ
Schwäbisch Hall, 1543/1615	17/1	L *choraliter vel figuraliter* (in plainchant or in figured music)	G (1526: L sung, then G)	L	?	?	?	Polyphony

4.12 Concordance of the orders quoted

Every order quoted or cited in this chapter is listed below by region. The table gives:

- **Sehling**: the volume and pages in Sehling's edition.
- **Doc**: the `eko.db` document that holds the text, for full-text lookup. A single database record may hold several orders.
- **§**: the sections where the order is quoted or cited ("A" = Appendix 4.A).

Saxony, Thuringia and central Germany

Order	Sehling	Doc	§
Luther, *Formula missae et communionis*, 1523	1, pp. 4–6	2	4.3.1, 4.4.1, 4.6.1, 4.7.1, 4.8.1, 4.9.1, 4.A.1
Allstedt, Thomas Müntzer, *Deutsch evangelisch Messe*, 1524 (Radical Reformation)	1, pp. 500–504	51, 52	4.3.2, 4.A.2, 4.A.5, 4.A.6, 4.A.8, 4.A.10
Allstedt, Thomas Müntzer, *Ordnung und berechnunge des teutschen ampts*, 1523/24 (Radical Reformation)	1, pp. 504–505	52	4.3.2, 4.5.2
Wittenberg, *Wie es einer zeit mit den ceremonien der messe gehalten*, 1525	1, p. 698	147	4.3.1, 4.7.2
Luther, *Deutsche Messe und ordnung gottis diensts*, 1526	1, p. 14	3	4.3.3, 4.5.3
Wittenberg, *Kirchen-Ordnung für die Stadt Wittenberg*, 1533	1, pp. 703–705	148	4.5.1, 4.8.2, 4.9.2
Albertine Saxony, *Kirchenordnunge zum anfang* (Duke Henry's *Agende*), 1539	1, pp. 89 (editor), 271	7, 30	4.3.3, 4.4.2, 4.8.1, 4.8.4
Albertine Saxony, *Instruktion zur zweiten Visitation*, 1539	1, p. 281	31	4.5.3, 4.8.2, 4.8.4
Gnandstein, visitation articles, 1539	1, p. 564	85	4.5.3
Wurzen, *Gemeine Artikel*, 1542	2, p. 98	1223	4.5.3
Gottleuba, *Verzeichnus der kirchenordnung*, 1567–1577	1, p. 567	87	4.10.4
Penig, *Kirchenordnung*, 1575	1, p. 634	116	4.10.4
Electoral Saxony, *Kirchenordnung* of Elector August, 1580	1, p. 368	44	4.4.2

Order	Sehling	Doc	§
Erfurt, *Deutsches Kirchenamt*, 1525	2, pp. 376–380	1251	4.3.2, 4.4.4, 4.6.3, 4.7.2, 4.9.1, 4.A.2, 4.A.5, 4.A.6, 4.A.8, 4.A.10
Naumburg, *Kirchen-Ordnung für die St. Wenzelskirche*, 1527, 1537/1538	2, pp. 60, 71	1218, 1219	4.7.3, 4.10.4
Merseburg, ordination Mass, 1545	2, p. 7	1210	4.4.5
Halle, *Kirchen-Ordnung der christlichen Gemein zu Halle*, 1543	2, p. 436	1257	4.5.3, 4.8.3, 4.10.3
Halberstadt, town order	2, p. 484	1260	4.8.1
Hatzkerode (Anhalt), *Kirchenordnunge*, 1534(?)	2, pp. 586–587	1263	4.4.3, 4.8.1
Schönburg lordships, *Kirchen-Ordnung* of Johann Pfeffinger, 1542	2, p. 171	1235	4.9.2
Henneberg, Meiningen, 1566	2, p. 339	1248	4.4.1

Brandenburg, Pomerania, Prussia and the Baltic

Order	Sehling	Doc	§
Brandenburg, *Kirchenordnung* of Joachim II, 1540	3, p. 71	1746	4.3.1, 4.6.2, 4.7.2, 4.9.1
Brandenburg, *Visitations- und Consistorialordnung*, 1573	3, p. 129	1748	4.5.3, 4.10.1
Brieg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1592	3, p. 445	1809	4.5.3
Teschen, *Kirchenordnung*, 1584	3, p. 462	1815	4.4.1
Prussia, *Artikel der ceremonien*, 1525	4, p. 32	1832	4.7.1
Prussia, *Kirchenordnung*, 1544; *Kirchenordnung und ceremonien*, 1568	4, pp. 65, 81	1833	4.8.1, 4.8.4
Pomerania, *Kirchenordnung*, 1535; *Pia ordinatio caeremoniarum*, 1535	4, pp. 341, 349	1856, 1857	4.5.1, 4.5.2, 4.5.3, 4.8.1
Pomerania, *Kirchenordnung*, 1542	4, pp. 357, 370	1859	4.8.1, 4.A
Pomerania, *Agenda*, 1569	4, p. 438	1865	4.6.2
Stralsund, *Entwurf einer Kirchenordnung*, 1555	4, p. 551	1889	4.8.1
Kurland, *Kurländische Kirchenordnung*, 1570	5, pp. 89–90	1907	4.8.2, 4.8.4, 4.A.6, 4.A.14, 4.A.15
Mecklenburg, *Ordeninge der misse*, 1545	5, pp. 151–154	1922	4.4.1, 4.4.2, 4.5.1, 4.5.3, 4.8.4, 4.10.1
Mecklenburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1552	5, pp. 199, 202	1922	4.5.3, 4.8.1, 4.A
Rostock, *Conformitas ceremoniarum*, 1560–1576	5, p. 288	1936	4.10.1
Hamburg, *Hamburger Kirchenordnung*, 1529	5, pp. 522, 528	1960	4.5.1, 4.8.2
Hamburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1556	5, p. 552	1963	4.4.3, 4.5.3, 4.8.1, 4.8.4

Lower Saxony, Westphalia and the north

Order	Sehling	Doc	§
Wolfenbüttel, *Christlike kerken-ordeninge*, 1543	6/1, p. 59	1972	4.8.2, 4.8.4
Wolfenbüttel, *Kirchenordnung* of Duke Julius, 1569	6/1, pp. 180–181	1974	4.A.1–4.A.9
Lüneburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1564	6/1, pp. 546, 574–575	2003, 2005	4.8.1, 4.A.1–4.A.9
Calenberg-Göttingen, *Kirchenordnung*, 1542	6/2, pp. 793–833	2036, 2037	4.3.2, 4.4.2, 4.5.3, 4.6.3, 4.7.3, 4.8.2, 4.A.2, 4.A.5–4.A.8, 4.A.10
Grubenhagen, *Kirchenordnung*, 1581	6/2, pp. 1073–1074	2058	4.8.2, 4.8.4, 4.A.2, 4.A.6, 4.A.8, 4.A.9, 4.A.12
Hoya, *Kirchenordnung*, 1581	6/2, pp. 1154–1155	2065	4.8.3, 4.A.1–4.A.2, 4.A.6–4.A.9
Verden, *Kirchenordnung*, 1606	7/1, pp. 206–207	2092	4.A.1–4.A.9
Osnabrück, *Agende* (1588) 1618	7/1, pp. 268–269	2100	4.8.2, 4.8.3, 4.8.4, 4.10.5, 4.A.1, 4.A.2, 4.A.6, 4.A.8
Engerhafe (East Frisia), *Liturgie*, 1583	7/1, pp. 677, 681	2119	4.8.1, 4.9.2
Nürnberg, *Bericht für den Goslarer Rat*, 1528	7/2.2, p. 230	2186	4.6.3, 4.10.3
Hildesheim, *Kirchenordnung*, 1544	7/2.1, pp. 853, 855	2136	4.6.1, 4.A
Oldenburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1573 (editors' notes)	7/2.1, p. 1085	2149	4.10.4
Herford, *Kirchenordnung*, 1532	21, p. 176	1442	4.8.2
Dortmund, *Gottesdienstordnung*, 1554	21, pp. 209–211	1446	4.7.3, 4.8.3, 4.A.1–4.A.11
Lippe, *Kirchenordnung* of Antonius Corvinus, 1542	21, p. 345	1460	4.8.3
Lippe, *Kirchenordnung*, 1571	21, pp. 410–411	1462	4.8.2, 4.8.3, 4.8.4, 4.A.1, 4.A.2, 4.A.6, 4.A.8, 4.A.13
Lippe, *Deutsche Messe*, [1525–1538]	22, p. 568	1549	4.7.3, 4.A.9
Wittgenstein, *Kirchenordnung*, 1555	22, p. 102	1493	4.3.2, 4.4.4
Schleswig-Holstein, *Kirchenordnung*, 1542	23, p. 90	1576	4.6.1
Kiel, Low German Mass, [after 1526]	23, p. 56	1576	4.A.6

Hesse

Order	Sehling	Doc	§
Hesse, *Agende*, 1574 (Philippist)	8, p. 411	2272	4.4.2

Franconia, Bavaria, the Palatinates and Swabia

Order	Sehling	Doc	§
Nürnberg, *Deutsche Messe* of Prior Volprecht, 1524	11, p. 39	247	4.7.1, 4.9.1
Nürnberg, *Gottesdienstordnung der Pfarrkirchen*, 1524	11, pp. 46–47	249	4.5.2, 4.7.1, 4.8.1
Weißenburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1528	11, p. 659	308	4.4.1, 4.6.2
Brandenburg-Nürnberg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1533	11, pp. 188, 195	270	4.4.1, 4.4.2, 4.6.2
Brandenburg-Ansbach, *Kirchenvisitation*, 1536	11, p. 326	277	4.9.1
Brandenburg-Ansbach-Kulmbach, *Auctuarium*, 1548 (Interim order)	11, pp. 329–330	278	4.6.2, 4.7.2
Nürnberg, *Agendbüchlein* of Veit Dietrich, 1545	11, p. 495	297	4.3.1
Schweinfurt, *Kirchenordnung*, 1543; *Gottesdienstordnung*, 1576	11, pp. 641, 648	304, 305	4.5.2, 4.10.4, 4.10.5
Hof, *Ordo ecclesiasticus*, 1592	11, pp. 409, 424, 432–473	294	4.4.4, 4.4.5, 4.5.1, 4.6.2, 4.8.4, 4.9.2, 4.10.1, 4.10.4, 4.10.5
Nördlingen, *Ordnung der ceremonien*, 1555	12, pp. 321, 325	373	4.9.2
Nördlingen, *Kirchenordnung*, 1579	12, p. 365	375	4.4.5, 4.10.4
Pfalz-Neuburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1543	13, pp. 70–71	386	4.4.2, 4.5.1, 4.6.2
Amberg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1550; 1555/1557	13, pp. 286, 291	411, 412	4.7.2, 4.8.4
Regensburg, *Kirchenordnung unter Justus Jonas*, 1553	13, p. 421	440	4.4.5, 4.9.2, 4.10.5
Kurpfalz, *Gemaine maß*, 1546	14, p. 96	472	4.4.3
Pfalz-Neuburg, *Kirchenordnung* of Ottheinrich, [1547]	14, p. 109	473	4.8.2, 4.8.4
Hohenlohe, *Kirchenordnung*, 1553	15, p. 68	539	4.4.1
Schwäbisch Hall, *Frühmessordnung*, 1526	17/1, p. 40	754	4.5.3
Schwäbisch Hall, *Kirchenordnung* 1543/1615	17/1, p. 162	762	4.10.4
Heilbronn, *Ordnung des Kirchengesangs*, 1543	17/1, p. 322	782	4.4.3, 4.10.5

Alsace

Order	Sehling	Doc	§
Strasbourg, Mass of Diebold Schwarz, and *Teutsche Meß und Tauff*, 1524 (Moderate Reformed)	20/1, pp. 121, 133–135	1279	4.3.2, 4.8.1, 4.A.2, 4.A.3, 4.A.5–4.A.8

Appendix 4.A The Proper Prefaces: texts and translations

This appendix gives every Proper Preface printed in the corpus, once for each distinct text, and lists the orders that carry it.

How the entries are laid out.

- **The Latin, where the corpus has it.** The Latin text is given first, from one witness, with the other witnesses listed and their variants noted. The English is translated from the Latin.

- **The German translations.** Each distinct German or Low German translation follows, with notes on where it shortens, adds to or changes the Latin.
- **German where the Latin is not in the corpus.** Some prefaces survive only in German: Lent, the Cross, the Blessed Virgin and the Apostles. The Latin of these is not printed anywhere in the corpus, so the English is made from the German. The note names the Latin preface of the Roman Missal that the German renders.
- **New German compositions.** Prefaces that are new German texts, not translations, are given last (§4.A.13–4.A.16).

Where the Latin set comes from. The Latin texts all belong to one Lower Saxon and Westphalian chain of orders:

- Lüneburg 1564;
- Wolfenbüttel 1569;
- Grubenhagen and Hoya 1581;
- Verden 1606;
- Osnabrück (1588) 1618;
- Lippe 1571.

These orders print the prefaces "with notes" at the end of the order or of the Mass. Sehling's editors refer them to the Roman Missal (*Röm. Meßbuch*) and to the *Missale Hildensemense* (Hildesheim Missal) of 1511 (Sehling 7/2.1, p. 855, n. 33).

Prefaces mentioned but not printed. Several orders printed prefaces that Sehling's edition does not reproduce:

- Mecklenburg 1540/45 ("There follow Prefaces, 35 pages, with notes");
- Mecklenburg 1552;
- Pomerania 1542 ("There follow 16 Prefaces with notes");
- Mansfeld 1580 ("a series of Prefaces");
- Buxtehude 1565, which has Christmas, Epiphany, Easter, Ascension, Pentecost, Trinity and the *Quotidiana* (daily [Preface]);
- Oldenburg 1573.

Their texts are not in the corpus. Where their headings are given, they match the Lower Saxon set.

Already in Chapter 7. The *common* Preface in German is also rendered in Chapter 7, for Kantz, Worms (Moderate Reformed), Volprecht, Döber and Bremen. Those renderings are not repeated here.

4.A.1 The dialogue and the common Preface (*Quotidiana*, *Praefatio communis*)

The common Preface frames every proper one. After *Vere dignum … aeterne Deus* (It is very meet … eternal God) the proper text is inserted, and it ends with its own *Et ideo* (And therefore) or *Per quem* (Through whom) clause. In the Lower Saxon orders the common Preface is also the festal Preface of **Michaelmas** (29 September) in Hoya 1581, Osnabrück 1618 and Lippe 1571. This is the only sanctoral use of a Latin Preface in the corpus (§4.8.3).

Latin witnesses:

- Lüneburg 1564 (Sehling 6/1, p. 574);
- Wolfenbüttel 1569 (6/1, p. 180);
- Verden 1606 (7/1, p. 206);
- Hoya 1581, "In die Michaelis" (On St. Michael's day; 6/2, p. 1155);
- Osnabrück (1588) 1618, "In die Michaelis" (7/1, pp. 268–269);
- Lippe 1571, "In die Michaelis" (21, p. 411).

Luther's *Formula missae* (1523) and the Nürnberg parish Mass of 1524 keep only the opening, cut off at *per Christum Dominum nostrum* (through Christ our Lord; §4.8.1).

Wolfenbüttel, *Kirchenordnung* of Duke Julius, 1569, "Quotidiana" (Sehling 6/1, p. 180):

The Lord be with you. And with thy spirit. Lift up your hearts. We lift them up unto the Lord. Let us give thanks unto the Lord our God. It is meet and right. It is very meet and right, just and wholesome, that we should at all times and in all places give thanks unto thee, O holy Lord, Father almighty, everlasting God, through Christ our Lord; through whom the Angels praise thy majesty, the Dominions adore, the Powers tremble, the heavens and the Virtues of the heavens and the blessed Seraphim with one

accord celebrate it with exultation. With whom we beseech thee that thou wouldest bid our voices also to be admitted, saying with lowly confession:

The German versions of the common Preface follow the Latin closely. The Low German of **Dortmund 1554** is a fair example. **Dortmund, *Gottesdienstordnung*, 1554, "Common or Daily Preface"** (Sehling 21, p. 211):

Notes on the German.

- The Low German doubles some terms: "right and fair, fitting and also wholesome" for *dignum et iustum, aequum et salutare* (meet and right, just and salutary).
- "With humble confession" becomes "humbly singing praise" (or "speaking praise"). The printed alternatives in brackets are the order's own.

Dortmund also gives the short form that Luther had made. It runs "through Christ our Lord, who in the night when he was betrayed took the bread" straight into the Words of Institution (Sehling 21, pp. 209–210).

4.A.2 Christmas (*Quia per incarnati Verbi mysterium*)

Latin witnesses:

- Lüneburg 1564 (6/1, p. 574);
- Wolfenbüttel 1569 (6/1, p. 180);
- Grubenhagen 1581 (6/2, p. 1073; reads *infulsit*, the Missal's reading, for *effulsit*);
- Hoya 1581 (6/2, p. 1154; *agnoscimus* for *cognoscimus*);
- Verden 1606 (7/1, p. 206);
- Osnabrück (1588) 1618 (7/1, p. 269; *caritatis* for *claritatis*);
- Lippe 1571 (21, p. 410).

Lüneburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1564, "On the day of the nativity of Christ" (Sehling 6/1, p. 574):

It is very meet, etc. … everlasting God: for by the mystery of the Word made flesh the new light of thy brightness hath shone upon the eyes of our mind; that while we know God visibly, we may by him be caught up into the love of things invisible. And therefore with Angels and Archangels, with Thrones and Dominions, and with all the company of the heavenly host, we sing the hymn of thy glory, evermore saying:

German (1): Müntzer's translation (Radical Reformation). Müntzer's *Deutsch evangelisch Messe* (1524) has this translation. So do the Erfurt *Deutsches Kirchenamt* (1525; Sehling 2, p. 379), Calenberg-Göttingen (1542; 6/2, p. 821) and Lippe 1571, "in the villages at Christmas" (21, p. 410). **Allstedt, Thomas Müntzer, *Deutsch evangelisch Messe*, 1524, Christmas office** (Radical Reformation; Sehling 1, pp. 501–502):

Notes on Müntzer's German.

- **Opening.** It begins at *quia* (because). The opening is "as in the Mass of Advent" (§4.A.11).
- ***Per hunc in invisibilium amorem rapiamur*** ("may by him be caught up into the love of things invisible") becomes "may come to the knowledge of the invisible Godhead". The words "by him" are dropped, and love becomes knowledge.
- **"with thrones and dominions"** becomes "with them in whom God reigneth": the Thrones are read as the seat of God.
- ***Omni militia coelestis exercitus*** becomes "all the heavenly company".
- ***Hymnum gloriae tuae canimus*** becomes "sing we a *Leise* to thy praise". A *Leise* (Leise (a vernacular hymn ending Kyrieleis)) is a vernacular hymn ending *Kyrieleis*.
- **Lippe 1571** substitutes "a song of praise of thy glory" for "a *Leise*".

German (2): Strasbourg (Moderate Reformed). **Strasbourg, *Teutsche Meß und Tauff*, 1524, "Some Prefaces"** (Moderate Reformed; Sehling 20/1, p. 133):

When thou hast read in the Preface shewn above the little word "everlasting God", there followeth: For by the mystery of the Word which was made flesh a new light of thy brightness hath appeared to the eyes of our mind; that, as we know God visibly, we may by him be drawn to the love of invisible things. Wherefore we with the Angels and all the heavenly hosts sing unto thee without ceasing the praise of thine honour, and say:

Notes on the Strasbourg German.

- This is a close translation, and it keeps *per hunc* ("through him") and *amorem* ("love").
- It drops the Archangels, Thrones and Dominions.
- It renders *sine fine* (without end) "without ceasing".
- The rubric shows that the proper text was spliced into the common Preface after *aeterne Deus* (eternal God), as in the Missal.

German (3): Dortmund (Low German). Dortmund, *Gottesdienstordnung*, 1554, "Preface for Christmas or Midwinter" (Sehling 21, p. 210):

Notes on the Dortmund Low German.

- This is a full and faithful translation, with every rank of angel kept.
- It offers an alternative, "by the incarnation of thy dear Son", for "the mystery of the Word made flesh".
- It renders *mentis* (of the mind) as "heart".

4.A.3 Epiphany (*Quia cum Unigenitus tuus*)

Latin witnesses: Lüneburg 1564 (6/1, p. 574), Wolfenbüttel 1569 (6/1, pp. 180–181) and Verden 1606 (7/1, pp. 206–207). Grubenhagen, Hoya, Osnabrück and Lippe have no Epiphany Preface.

Lüneburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1564, "On the day of the Epiphany" (Sehling 6/1, p. 574):

It is very meet and right, etc. … everlasting God: for when thine Only-begotten appeared in the substance of our mortality, he restored us by the new light of his immortality. And therefore with Angels and Archangels, with Thrones and Dominions, and with all the company of the heavenly host, we sing the hymn of thy glory, evermore saying:

Note. The Lower Saxon orders print *qui cum* (who, when) where the Missal has *quia cum* (for when).

German: Strasbourg (Moderate Reformed). **Strasbourg, *Teutsche Meß und Tauff*, 1524, "Another Preface"** (Moderate Reformed; Sehling 20/1, p. 133):

Everlasting God, when thine only-begotten Son appeared in the being of our mortality, he restored us with the new light of his immortality, etc.; wherefore we, etc., as standeth above.

Note. The translation is exact; *substantia* (substance) becomes "being".

German: Dortmund (Low German). Dortmund, *Gottesdienstordnung*, 1554, "On the Manifestation of Christ, or the Kings' Day" (Sehling 21, p. 210):

For when thine only-begotten Son appeared in the form (or: in the substance or being) of our mortality, he made us anew with the new light of his immortality. Therefore, etc., as above.

4.A.4 Lent (*Qui corporali ieiunio*)

Witness: Dortmund 1554 only. No Latin Lenten Preface is printed in the corpus. The Low German renders the Missal's *Qui corporali ieiunio vitia comprimis, mentem elevas, virtutem largiris et praemia* (Who by bodily fasting dost restrain vices, lift up the mind, and bestow virtue and rewards), faithfully. **Dortmund, *Gottesdienstordnung*, 1554, "In Lent"** (Sehling 21, p. 210):

[It is very meet … everlasting God:] Who by bodily fasting dost suppress our faults, lift up the heart, and give us virtue and reward; through Christ our Lord, through whom, etc., as below in the common Preface.

4.A.5 Passiontide and the Holy Cross (*Qui salutem humani generis in ligno crucis*)

Witnesses: Müntzer 1524 (Radical Reformation; 1, p. 502), Erfurt 1525 (2, p. 380), Calenberg-Göttingen 1542 (6/2, p. 826), Strasbourg 1524 (Moderate Reformed; 20/1, p. 121) and Dortmund 1554 (21, p. 210).

- Müntzer, Erfurt and Calenberg use it in the Mass "of the suffering of Christ".
- Strasbourg puts it in its ordinary Sunday Mass.

- Dortmund uses it "of the Cross and Passion of Christ".

No Latin text of this Preface is printed in the corpus. The German renders the Missal's "Who didst set the salvation of mankind upon the tree of the cross, that whence death arose, thence life might rise again, and that he who overcame by the tree might also by the tree be overcome".

German (1): Müntzer (Radical Reformation). Müntzer's translation is also in Erfurt and Calenberg. **Allstedt, Thomas Müntzer, *Deutsch evangelisch Messe*, 1524, office of the Passion** (Radical Reformation; Sehling 1, p. 502):

Verily it is worthy and right, meet and wholesome, that we should at all times give thanks unto thee, O Lord, almighty everlasting God: who hast set forth the salvation of mankind on the wood of the cross, that whence death had sprung, thence life might rise again; through Christ our Lord, through whom the Angels praise thy glory, etc.

Note. Müntzer **omits the last clause** of the Latin, "and that he who by a tree overcame might also by a tree be overcome". Erfurt and Calenberg follow him. Calenberg completes the ending with the full German common Preface, "through whom the angels praise … saying without end".

German (2): Strasbourg, Schwarz (Moderate Reformed). Diebold Schwarz's Strasbourg Mass expands that last clause with a reference to Adam and to the obedience shown on the tree. **Strasbourg, Mass of Diebold Schwarz, 1524** (Moderate Reformed; Sehling 20/1, p. 121):

It is fitting in truth, and meet, right and wholesome, that we should always and in all places give thanks unto thee, O Lord, holy, almighty Father, everlasting God, who hast wrought our salvation by the wood of the cross, that life might come from that from which death had arisen; and that the enemy, who through the transgression at the tree had overcome us all in Adam, might be overcome again through the obedience rendered on the tree; through Christ Jesus our Lord, through whose majesty and glory the angels and all the heavenly chivalry praise thee, and with like exultation together extol and laud thee; with whom we pray thee to accept our voices also, with humble confession, and we say:

Notes on Schwarz's German.

- The Latin's "he who overcame by a tree" is glossed as **the devil**, who conquered "through the transgression at the tree" "in Adam".
- The Latin's "might be overcome by a tree" becomes **"through obedience rendered on the tree"**. Christ's obedience is set against Adam's disobedience (Rom 5:19).
- The angelic orders of the common Preface are reduced to "the angels and all the heavenly chivalry".

German (3): Dortmund (Low German). Dortmund renders the whole Latin, the last clause included. **Dortmund, *Gottesdienstordnung*, 1554, "Of the Cross and Passion of Christ"** (Sehling 21, p. 210):

[It is very meet … everlasting God:] Who hast wrought the salvation of mankind on the wood of the Cross, that whence death had come, thence life might rise again; and that he who had overcome by the tree might in turn be overcome on the tree; through Christ our Lord, through whom, etc., below in the common Preface.

4.A.6 Easter (*Te quidem, Domine, omni tempore*)

Latin witnesses:

- Lüneburg 1564 (6/1, p. 574);
- Wolfenbüttel 1569 (6/1, p. 181);
- Grubenhagen 1581 (6/2, p. 1074);
- Hoya 1581 (6/2, p. 1154). It prints *verus est Deus* (he is the true God) for *verus est agnus* (he is the true Lamb), which Sehling's editor takes for a misprint;
- Verden 1606 (7/1, p. 207);
- Osnabrück (1588) 1618 (7/1, p. 269);
- Lippe 1571 (21, p. 410).

Lüneburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1564, "On Easter Day" (Sehling 6/1, p. 574):

It is very meet and right, just and wholesome, at all times indeed to praise thee, O Lord, but chiefly on this day more gloriously, when Christ our Passover was sacrificed. For he is the very Lamb, which hath taken away the sins of the world; who by dying hath destroyed our death, and by rising again hath restored life. And therefore with Angels and Archangels, with Thrones and Dominions, and with all the company of the heavenly host, we sing the hymn of thy glory, evermore saying:

German (1): Müntzer (Radical Reformation). This translation is in Müntzer 1524 and Erfurt 1525 (2, p. 376). It is also in Calenberg-Göttingen 1542 (6/2, p. 829) and Lippe 1571, "in the villages" (21, p. 410). The Low German Mass from Kiel has it too (Sehling 23, p. 56; rendered in Chapter 7, §7.11.2). **Allstedt, Thomas Müntzer, *Deutsch evangelisch Messe*, 1524, office of the Resurrection** (Radical Reformation; Sehling 1, p. 503):

Notes on Müntzer's German.

- **The opening is the common Preface's.** "at all times indeed, O Lord, … to praise thee" is replaced by "that we give thanks unto thee in all places, and specially at this time praise thee more highly". The Latin's own "at all times indeed to praise thee" disappears into the common formula.
- ***In hac potissimum die*** ("chiefly on this day") becomes **"at this time"**, so the Preface serves the whole Easter season.
- ***Mortem nostram*** becomes "our **eternal** death".
- **The *Et ideo* is reduced** to "with all the angels of the heavenly hosts", and "the hymn" becomes "a *Leise*".
- **The Kiel Mass** adds that Christ died "by his **temporal** death". Lippe 1571 reads "a song of praise" for "a Leise".

German (2): Kurland. Kurland 1570 has its own translation. **Kurland, *Kurländische Kirchenordnung*, 1570, "For Easter"** (Sehling 5, p. 90):

Notes on Kurland's German. It follows Müntzer's shape. It adds "**on the cross**" to "sacrificed for us", and it says that Christ by his death "overcame death" instead of "destroyed our death".

German (3): Strasbourg (Moderate Reformed). **Strasbourg, *Teutsche Meß und Tauff*, 1524, "Another Preface"** (Moderate Reformed; Sehling 20/1, p. 133):

[It is] right and wholesome that thou be always gloriously extolled and praised; for Christ our Passover is slain. He is the true Lamb, that taketh away the sin of the world; who by dying hath destroyed our death, and by rising again hath restored life. Wherefore we, etc.

Note. Strasbourg keeps the Latin's own opening ("always … gloriously praised"). But it **drops *sed in hac potissimum die***: there is no "chiefly on this day".

German (4): Dortmund (Low German). Dortmund, *Gottesdienstordnung*, 1554, "For Easter" (Sehling 21, p. 210):

[It is very meet … wholesome,] to praise thee indeed, O Lord, at all times, but chiefly upon this day (or: this time) more festally, wherein Christ our Passover is offered. The same is the true Lamb, that hath taken away the sin of the world; who by his dying hath broken our death, and by his rising hath made life anew. Therefore, etc., as above at Christmas.

Note. This is complete and faithful. "Chiefly upon this day" is kept, with "this time" offered as an alternative, as in Müntzer.

German (5): the Easter text as Calenberg's Sunday Preface. Calenberg-Göttingen 1542 prints a shorter form of the Easter Preface in its model Mass for an ordinary Sunday. That Mass has the Trinity propers: the Alleluia *Benedictus es, Domine, Deus patrum nostrorum* (Blessed art thou, O Lord God of our fathers) and the Gospel John 3. **Calenberg-Göttingen, *Kirchenordnung*, 1542** (Sehling 6/2, p. 815):

Verily it is meet and right and wholesome that we give thanks unto thee, holy Lord, almighty Father, everlasting God, through Christ our Lord, who is the true Passover lamb; he is verily the Lamb that beareth the sin of the world, who by his dying hath destroyed our death, and by his resurrection hath won life. Therefore we sing with his angels and archangels a song of praise to thine honour, without end saying:

Note. All reference to the day and the season is gone. The Easter Preface becomes a **Sunday Preface**: every Sunday is a feast of the resurrection.

4.A.7 Ascension (*Qui post resurrectionem suam*)

Latin witnesses:

- Lüneburg 1564 (6/1, p. 574);
- Wolfenbüttel 1569 (6/1, p. 181);
- Hoya 1581 (6/2, p. 1155; *faceret* for *tribueret*);
- Verden 1606 (7/1, p. 207).

Lüneburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1564, "Of the Ascension" (Sehling 6/1, p. 574):

It is very meet, etc. … through Christ our Lord: who after his resurrection appeared openly unto all his disciples, and in their sight was lifted up into heaven, that he might grant us to be partakers of his Godhead. And therefore with Angels and Archangels, with Thrones and Dominions, and with all the company of the heavenly host, we sing the hymn of thy glory, evermore saying:

German (1): Strasbourg (Moderate Reformed). **Strasbourg, *Teutsche Meß und Tauff*, 1524, "Another Preface"** (Moderate Reformed; Sehling 20/1, p. 134):

Everlasting God, through Christ our Lord, who after his resurrection appeared openly to his disciples, and in their sight was lifted up into heaven, that he might make us partakers of his Godhead; wherefore we, etc.

Note. The translation is exact, but it leaves out "all" (*omnibus*).

German (2): Calenberg-Göttingen. Calenberg-Göttingen, *Kirchenordnung*, 1542, Ascension (Sehling 6/2, p. 831):

Notes on Calenberg's German.

- This is a full and faithful translation.
- "with thrones and dominions" becomes "ruling and mighty angels", and "with all the host of the heavenly army" becomes "the lordship of the heavenly hosts".
- Sehling's editor notes that the text is close to the Erfurt *Kirchenamt* of 1526.

German (3): Dortmund (Low German). Dortmund, *Gottesdienstordnung*, 1554, "The Ascension of Christ" (Sehling 21, p. 210):

[It is very meet …] through Christ our Lord, who after his resurrection shewed himself clearly to all his disciples, and this day, in sight before their eyes, went up into heaven, that he might make us partakers of his Godhead. Therefore, etc., [as] at Christmas.

Note. Dortmund adds "**this day**" .

4.A.8 Pentecost (*Qui ascendens super omnes caelos*)

Latin witnesses:

- Lüneburg 1564 (6/1, pp. 574–575);
- Wolfenbüttel 1569 (6/1, p. 181);
- Grubenhagen 1581 (6/2, p. 1074);
- Hoya 1581 (6/2, p. 1155);
- Verden 1606 (7/1, p. 207);
- Osnabrück (1588) 1618 (7/1, p. 269);
- Lippe 1571 (21, p. 411).

The *canimus* variant. Lüneburg, Wolfenbüttel and Hoya read ***canimus*** ("we sing") where the Missal has *concinunt* ("[the Powers] sing together"). Sehling's editor marks it "[!]" in Hoya. The grammar is broken, but the sense is that the congregation joins the angels. The others read *concinunt*. In Grubenhagen the editor has restored *concinunt* against a print reading *canimus* (we sing).

Lüneburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1564, "Of Pentecost" (Sehling 6/1, pp. 574–575):

It is very meet and right, etc. … through Christ our Lord: who, ascending above all the heavens, and sitting at thy right hand, did on this day pour forth the promised Holy Ghost upon the children of adoption. Wherefore with overflowing joy the whole world throughout all the earth doth exult; and the Virtues on high and the angelic Powers also [with them] we sing the hymn of thy glory, evermore saying:

German (1): Müntzer (Radical Reformation). Müntzer's translation is also in Erfurt 1525 (2, p. 377), Calenberg-Göttingen 1542 (6/2, p. 833) and Lippe 1571, "in the villages" (21, p. 411). In Sehling's edition Müntzer's Pentecost office is printed at the head of the following document (*eko.db* doc 52). **Allstedt, Thomas Müntzer, *Deutsch evangelisch Messe*, 1524, office of the Holy Ghost** (Radical Reformation; Sehling 1, p. 504):

Notes on Müntzer's German.

- ***Super omnes caelos*** ("above all the heavens") becomes "into heaven".
- ***In filios adoptionis*** ("upon the children of adoption") becomes **"upon the elect children"**.
- ***Profusis gaudiis*** is dropped.
- ***Supernae virtutes atque angelicae potestates*** becomes "all the heavenly host", who "sing a *Leise*".

German (2): Strasbourg (Moderate Reformed). **Strasbourg, *Teutsche Meß und Tauff*, 1524, "Another Preface"** (Moderate Reformed; Sehling 20/1, p. 134):

Everlasting God, through Christ our Lord, who, ascended above all heavens and sitting at thy right hand, hath poured out the promised Spirit upon thy children taken in the stead of children; wherefore with overflowing joys in all the earth the world rejoiceth, and the Angels also sing thy praise and say: Sanctus, Holy, etc.

Note. This is close, and it keeps "above all heavens" and "adoption". It drops ***hodierna die***, "on this day".

German (3): Dortmund (Low German). Dortmund, *Gottesdienstordnung*, 1554, "Pentecost" (Sehling 21, pp. 210–211):

[It is very meet …] through Christ our Lord, who, ascending above all heavens and sitting at thy right hand, hath (on this day) poured out the promised Holy Ghost upon the chosen children; whereof the whole world rejoiceth exceedingly; yea, the highest Virtues also and the angelic Powers sing the praise of thy glory, without end saying: Holy, etc.

Notes on Dortmund's German. Dortmund agrees with Müntzer's "**chosen children**" against the Latin's "children of adoption". It puts "today" in brackets as optional, and it has *concinunt*, not *canimus*.

4.A.9 Trinity (*Qui cum unigenito Filio tuo*)

Latin witnesses:

- Lüneburg 1564 (6/1, p. 575);
- Wolfenbüttel 1569 (6/1, p. 181);
- Grubenhagen 1581 (6/2, p. 1074);
- Hoya 1581 (6/2, p. 1155; *essentiae* for *substantiae*);
- Verden 1606 (7/1, p. 207).

Several orders also prescribe it for **ordinary Sundays** (§4.8.2): Wolfenbüttel 1543, Hamburg 1529, Herford 1532 and Wittenberg 1533. The reason they give is that the Preface "was made against the Arians".

Lüneburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1564, "Of the Trinity" (Sehling 6/1, p. 575):

It is very meet and right, just and wholesome, that we should at all times and in all places give thanks unto thee, O holy Lord, Father almighty, everlasting God: who with thine only-begotten Son and the Holy Ghost art one God, one Lord; not in the singleness of one Person, but in the Trinity of one substance. For that which by thy revelation we believe of thy glory, the same we believe of thy Son, the same of the Holy Ghost, without any difference or separation; that in the confession of the true and everlasting Godhead there may be adored in the Persons propriety, in the essence unity, and in the majesty equality: which the Angels praise, the Dominions adore, the Powers tremble at, the heavens and the Virtues of the heavens and the blessed Seraphim with one accord celebrate with exultation. With whom we beseech thee that thou wouldest bid our voices also to be admitted, saying with lowly confession:

Note. The ending is that of the common Preface: "whom the angels praise, the dominions adore …". It is not the "the Cherubim also and Seraphim, who cease not to cry" of the later Roman form.

German (1): Lippe, Low German. Lippe, *Deutsche Messe*, [1525–1538], Trinity Sunday (Sehling 22, p. 568):

Notes on the Lippe Low German.

- ***Sed in unius trinitate substantiae*** ("but in the Trinity of one substance") becomes "but in the **unity** of one peculiar being". The word "Trinity" is lost.
- ***Sine differentia discretionis*** ("without difference or separation") becomes "**that same we hold distinctly** of thy Son and the Holy Ghost". The negative is lost, and the clause seems to say the opposite of the Latin.
- **The angelic ending** follows the other Roman form: "the angels praise, the archangels worship, and Cherubim and Seraphim … sing without ceasing with one voice". Compare "Angels and Archangels, the Cherubim also and Seraphim, who cease not to cry".

German (2): Dortmund (Low German). Dortmund, *Gottesdienstordnung*, 1554, "Of the Holy Trinity" (Sehling 21, p. 211):

[It is very meet … everlasting God:] Who with thine only-begotten Son and the Holy Ghost art one God, one Lord; not in the oneness of a person, but in the trinity of one being. For what we believe of thy glory through thy revealing, that we feel also of thy Son and of the Holy Ghost, without any difference [or] change; so that in the confession of the true, everlasting Godhead a distinction in the Persons, a unity in the being, and yet an equality in the glory be adored. Which the Angels praise, etc., as in the common Preface.

Note. This is faithful. *Proprietas* becomes "a distinction", and *discretionis* becomes "change".

4.A.10 The Blessed Virgin (*Et te in … beatae Mariae*), and Müntzer's Advent rewording

Witnesses:

- **Dortmund 1554:** the Marian Preface itself, for the Purification, Annunciation, Visitation, Assumption and Nativity of Mary.
- **Müntzer 1524 (Advent; Radical Reformation), Erfurt 1525 (Trinity, also used in Advent) and Calenberg-Göttingen 1542 (Advent):** a reworded form, which turns the praise of Mary's feast into thanksgiving for the Incarnation.

No Latin text is printed in the corpus. The German renders the Missal's "And to praise, bless and proclaim thee on the [feast] of the blessed Mary ever Virgin; who conceived thine only-begotten Son by the overshadowing of the Holy Ghost, and, the glory of her virginity remaining, shed forth upon the world the eternal light, Jesus Christ our Lord."

German (1): Dortmund (Low German), the Marian feasts. Dortmund, *Gottesdienstordnung*, 1554, "On the feasts of Mary" (Sehling 21, p. 211):

[It is very meet … to give thanks unto thee,] and on thy day (of the Purification, of the Annunciation, of the Visitation or Going over the Mountain, of the Assumption, of the Nativity, etc.) of Mary, the holy, ever Virgin, with joyful hearts together to praise, bless and highly extol; who conceived thine only-begotten Son by the overshadowing of the Holy Ghost, and, the honour of her virginity remaining, brought forth to this world the everlasting light, Jesus Christ our Lord; through whom, etc., in the common Preface.

Notes on Dortmund's German.

- **"Thy day … of Mary".** The Missal's "in the festival of blessed Mary" becomes "on **thy** day … of Mary". The feast is God's, and the Virgin is its occasion.
- **The Assumption is still listed** ("of the Assumption", 15 August).
- *Effudit* ("poured forth") becomes "brought forth".

German (2): Müntzer's rewording for Advent (Radical Reformation). Müntzer's form is also in Erfurt 1525 (2, p. 378) and Calenberg-Göttingen 1542 (6/2, p. 818). **Allstedt, Thomas Müntzer, *Deutsch evangelisch Messe*, 1524, office of Advent** (Radical Reformation; Sehling 1, p. 500):

Verily it is meet and right and wholesome that we should at all times and in all places give thanks unto thee, O Lord, holy Father, almighty, everlasting God. For thou hast received thy holy manhood of the Virgin Mary by the overshadowing of the Holy Ghost, so that she with unblemished chastity brought the everlasting light into the world, Jesus Christ our Lord: through whom the angels praise thy glory, and the angels in whom thou reignest do thee honour; the mighty angels tremble; and the heavens and the powers of the heavens and the holy Seraphim praise thee without ceasing with one accord of joy. Therefore we pray thee, O Lord, that thou wouldest admit our voices with them, that we may praise thee with true confession, without end saying:

Notes on Müntzer's rewording.

- **Mary's feast is gone.** The clause "and on the festival of blessed Mary to praise, bless and proclaim thee" is struck out.
- **The subject changes.** It is no longer Mary who "conceived thine Only-begotten". It is God who "received thy holy manhood of the Virgin Mary". The Preface becomes a thanksgiving for the Incarnation, fit for Advent.
- **The common ending is translated**, with *dominationes* as "the angels in whom thou reignest".
- **Erfurt 1525** prints the same text in its Trinity office. Its Advent office takes the whole Preface from there, and its Passion office takes "the beginning together with the conclusion" (Sehling 2, pp. 379–380).

4.A.11 The Apostles (*Et te, Domine, suppliciter exorare*)

Witness: Dortmund 1554 only. No Latin is printed in the corpus. The Low German renders the Missal's "And humbly to beseech thee, O Lord, that thou, the eternal Shepherd, forsake not thy flock, but keep it by thy blessed Apostles with continual protection; that it may be governed by those same rulers whom thou didst set over it as shepherds, the vicars of thy work." **Dortmund, *Gottesdienstordnung*, 1554, "Of the Apostles"** (Sehling 21, p. 211):

[It is very meet … wholesome,] humbly to beseech thee, O Lord, that thou, O everlasting Shepherd, forsake not thy sheep, but through the doctrine of thy holy Apostles keep them in continual guard from all error; that they may be led by the doctrine of the same rulers, whom thou hast given them for shepherds, stewards of thy work, to be over them in thy stead in the word. Therefore with the Angels and Archangels, etc., above, at Christmas.

Notes on Dortmund's German.

- **"Through thy blessed Apostles" becomes "through the doctrine of thy holy Apostles … from all error".** The Apostles keep the flock by their teaching, not by their intercession.
- **"By the same rulers" becomes "by the doctrine of the same rulers"**, again teaching, not rule.
- ***Vicarios*** becomes "stewards … in thy stead **in the word**".

4.A.12 Passiontide and Maundy Thursday: Grubenhagen's Isaiah 53 Preface (new German text)

Witness: Grubenhagen 1581. "So that the simple layman may be awakened more devoutly to the contemplation of the sufferings and death of Christ", the order adds "a German preface taken from the 53rd chapter of Isaiah". It is to be sung "on Maundy Thursday, or else at any time when there are many communicants". It is a new composition with notes, built on the frame of the German common Preface. **Grubenhagen, *Kirchenordnung*, 1581** (Sehling 6/2, p. 1074):

Verily it is meet and right, laudable and also wholesome, that we should give thanks unto thee, God the Father, evermore and everlastingly, for that thou hast given us thy dear Son, who by his bitter suffering hath paid what Adam and we had deserved; as Isaiah saith: Surely he hath borne our griefs and carried our sorrows. He was wounded for our transgressions, he was bruised for our iniquities; the chastisement is upon him, that we might have peace, and with his stripes we are healed. All we like sheep have gone astray, as sheep that have no shepherd; we have turned every one to his own way. But the Lord laid on him the sin of us all, an unbearable burden, under which he sweat bloody sweat, and on the stem of the cross cried: My God, my God, why hast thou forsaken me? that we might not be forsaken for ever. Therefore with the angels and archangels, with the thrones and the dominions, and with all the heavenly host, we sing unto thee the hymn of thine honour, evermore and ever saying:

4.A.13 Michaelmas: Lippe's German Preface for the villages (new German text)

Witness: Lippe 1571. For the towns, Lippe sets the Latin common Preface "In die Michaelis" (On St. Michael's day) (§4.A.1). For the villages it gives a German Preface of its own. This keeps the opening of the common Preface but replaces the choirs of angels with the forgiveness of sins. On the feast of St Michael and All Angels, the angels are named only in the Sanctus. **Lippe, *Kirchenordnung*, 1571, "On St. Michael's day in the villages"** (Sehling 21, p. 411):

Verily it is meet and right and wholesome that we should at all times and in all places give thanks unto thee, O Lord, holy Father, almighty, everlasting God, through Christ our Lord: for whose sake thou sparest us, forgivest us our sins, and promisest everlasting welfare. Wherefore we thankfully sing a song of praise of thy glory, without end saying: Holy.

4.A.14 Christmas in Kurland: the Easter Preface with the Nativity prefixed (new German text)

Witness: Kurland 1570. "On the high feasts, for variation (as is done at the princely court)", the minister may sing "these prefaces noted below, in place of the *quotidiana*". The **Christmas** Preface is not the Roman Christmas text. It is the German Easter Preface,

with the Virgin Birth set in front of the Lamb. The minister and choir sing the dialogue in alternation. The Easter Preface follows (§4.A.6, German 2), then a Pentecost Preface, which is the Easter text again with the Ascension and the sending of the Spirit added (§4.A.15). **Kurland, *Kurländische Kirchenordnung*, 1570, "For the Nativity"** (Sehling 5, pp. 89–90):

The minister: The Lord be with you. The choir: And with thy spirit. The minister: Lift up your hearts. The choir: We lift them up unto the Lord. The minister: Let us give thanks unto God our Lord. The choir: It is meet and right. The minister: Verily it is meet and right, and withal wholly wholesome, that we should at all times and in all places give thanks unto thee, and especially at this time praise thee more highly, because a tender little maiden hath borne unto us the Son of God, who is the true Lamb of God that hath taken away the sin of the world; who by his dying hath overcome death, and by his resurrection hath brought life again. Therefore with all the angels and with all the heavenly hosts we sing a song of praise of thy glory, without end saying:

4.A.15 Pentecost in Kurland: the Easter Preface with the Ascension and Pentecost added (new German text)

Witness: Kurland 1570. This is the Easter Preface of §4.A.6 (German 2), extended. Before the Sanctus it adds that Christ, "when he was taken visibly into heaven", sent down the Comforter. **Kurland, *Kurländische Kirchenordnung*, 1570, "For Pentecost"** (Sehling 5, p. 90):

Verily it is meet and right, and withal wholly wholesome, that we should at all times and in all places give thanks unto thee, and especially at this time praise thee more highly, because Christ our Passover lamb is sacrificed for us upon the cross, who is the true Lamb of God that hath taken away the sin of the world; who by his dying hath overcome death and by his resurrection hath brought life again; and when he was taken up visibly into heaven, he sent down the Comforter, the Holy Ghost, upon his faithful. Therefore with all the angels and with all the heavenly hosts we sing a song of praise of thy glory, without end saying:

4.A.16 Summary: which Prefaces each order has

Preface	Latin in the corpus	German or Low German in the corpus
Common (*Quotidiana*)	Lüneburg 1564, Wolfenbüttel 1569, Verden 1606; for Michaelmas: Hoya 1581, Osnabrück 1618, Lippe 1571; cut short: Luther 1523, Nürnberg 1524	Dortmund 1554; Kantz, Worms (Moderate Reformed), Volprecht, Döber, Bremen (see Chapter 7)
Christmas	Lüneburg, Wolfenbüttel, Grubenhagen, Hoya, Verden, Osnabrück, Lippe 1571	Müntzer 1524 (Radical Reformation), Erfurt 1525, Calenberg 1542, Lippe 1571; Strasbourg 1524 (Moderate Reformed); Dortmund 1554; Kurland 1570 (new text, §4.A.14)
Epiphany	Lüneburg, Wolfenbüttel, Verden	Strasbourg 1524 (Moderate Reformed); Dortmund 1554
Lent	—	Dortmund 1554
Passion and Cross	—	Müntzer (Radical Reformation), Erfurt, Calenberg; Strasbourg (Schwarz) 1524 (Moderate Reformed); Dortmund 1554; Grubenhagen 1581 (new Isaiah 53 text, §4.A.12)
Easter	Lüneburg, Wolfenbüttel, Grubenhagen, Hoya, Verden, Osnabrück, Lippe 1571	Müntzer (Radical Reformation), Erfurt, Calenberg, Lippe 1571, Kiel; Kurland 1570; Strasbourg 1524 (Moderate Reformed); Dortmund 1554; Calenberg's Sunday form
Ascension	Lüneburg, Wolfenbüttel, Hoya, Verden	Strasbourg 1524 (Moderate Reformed); Calenberg 1542; Dortmund 1554
Pentecost	Lüneburg, Wolfenbüttel, Grubenhagen, Hoya, Verden, Osnabrück, Lippe 1571	Müntzer (Radical Reformation), Erfurt, Calenberg, Lippe 1571; Strasbourg 1524 (Moderate Reformed); Dortmund 1554; Kurland 1570 (§4.A.15)

Preface	Latin in the corpus	German or Low German in the corpus
Trinity	Lüneburg, Wolfenbüttel, Grubenhagen, Hoya, Verden	Lippe 1525; Dortmund 1554
Blessed Virgin	—	Dortmund 1554; Müntzer (Radical Reformation), Erfurt, Calenberg (reworded for Advent and Trinity)
Apostles	—	Dortmund 1554
Michaelmas (new German text)	(common Preface)	Lippe 1571 (§4.A.13)

Chapter 5. Collect, Secret and Postcommunion

This chapter follows the three **presidential prayers** of the medieval Mass through the evangelical church orders printed in Emil Sehling's *Die evangelischen Kirchenordnungen des XVI. Jahrhunderts* (The Evangelical Church Orders of the Sixteenth Century):

- the **collect** (*collecta*, *oratio*), said after the Gloria and before the epistle;
- the **secret** (*secreta*, *oratio super oblata*), said silently over the gifts at the end of the offertory;
- the **postcommunion** (*postcommunio*, *complenda*, *ad complendum*), said after the communion;
- on the weekdays of Lent, a fourth: the **prayer over the people** (*oratio super populum*), said after the postcommunion before the dismissal.

In the medieval rite all three were **proper**: each Sunday and feast had its own set, printed together in the Missal. They were also **multiplied**. A Mass of the day could add the collect of a commemorated feast or octave, or a votive prayer (for peace, for rain, for the ruler). Each added collect brought its own secret and postcommunion with it, so that two collects meant two secrets and two postcommunions.

For each prayer the chapter asks:

- What did the Lutheran orders **keep** of the old system?
- What did they **strip**?
- What did they **add**?
- What did they **alter**?

It gives particular attention to the claim that the postcommunion was **standardized into a fixed prayer**, Luther's thanksgiving of 1526, and to the other postcommunions that stood beside it, among them versions of the old Missal prayers.

How the chapter is laid out.

- §5.1 summarizes the findings, and §5.2 sets out the method and cautions.
- §5.3 describes the medieval system and Luther's two rulings, of 1523 and 1526.
- §5.4 deals with the collect, §5.5 with the secret, and §5.6 with the postcommunion and, in §5.6.6, the Lenten prayer over the people.
- §5.7 sets out what was kept, stripped, added and altered.
- §5.8 is a table by order, and §5.9 a concordance.
- Appendix 5.A lists the postcommunion texts and their sources.

5.1 Summary of findings

1. Luther set the pattern in two steps (§5.3).

- **1523, *Formula missae*.** One collect of the day only, "if it be godly". No secret, because it fell with the offertory. The proper postcommunions were rejected because "they almost all sound of sacrifice". In their place came two of the priest's ablution prayers, *Quod ore sumpsimus* (What we have taken with our mouth) and *Corpus tuum* (Thy body), the same every Sunday.
- **1526, *Deutsche Messe*.** One German collect, and one fixed German thanksgiving after the communion: "We give thanks to thee, almighty Lord God, that thou hast refreshed us through this salutary gift …". Sehling's Verden editor, after P. Drews, traces this prayer to the Missal postcommunion of the eighteenth Sunday after Pentecost, *Gratias tibi referimus … sacro munere vegetati* (We give thee thanks … being quickened by the sacred gift). Luther changed its petition from "make us worthy" to "make it prosper in us unto faith and love".

2. The collect: kept, proper, and mostly from the Missal (§5.4).

- **Kept de tempore.** Every order with a Mass has a collect after the Gloria, of the season or feast. The territorial orders print German series by the church year (Saxony 1539 and 1580, Lüneburg 1564, Wolfenbüttel 1569, Henneberg 1582, Grubenhagen 1581, Oldenburg 1573, Verden 1606, Osnabrück 1618).
- **From the Missal.** Sehling's editors trace many of these collects to Missal collects (*Excita*, *Concede … nova per carnem nativitas* [Grant … that the new birth in the flesh], *Deus qui hodierna die corda fidelium* [O God, who on this day didst teach

the hearts of the faithful]), mostly by way of the Wittenberg hymnbook of 1533 and the translations of Michael Coelius.

- **Reduced to one, with exceptions.** Luther's rule of one collect was common (Volprecht 1524, Mecklenburg 1545). But a **second collect for need** survived: Mecklenburg allows it, and Ansbach 1548 requires two, the first for spiritual and the second for temporal things. Hof 1592 has the votive "for rain and fair weather". The collect for peace after *Verleih uns Frieden* (Grant us peace; *Deus, a quo sancta desideria*) became the standing second collect at the end of the service.
- **Purged.** Collects asking the intercession of the saints went (Hannover 1536). The rest were kept "if pure" (Amberg 1550, Henneberg 1582).
- **Added.** Veit Dietrich's **gospel collects** (from 1546) were written on the day's gospel rather than the season. Wolfenbüttel 1569 and Soest 1609 allow them. In Buxtehude 1565 each Sunday has two collects, a Missal collect before the sermon and Dietrich's after it.
- **Altered.** Collects moved into German so the people could answer Amen (Coburg 1554/55, Wolfstein 1574). Hof 1592 still teaches the medieval rules for the collect conclusions.

3. The secret: abolished (§5.5).

- **No secret in any order.** No order keeps a secret, and the corpus has no German version of one. It fell with the offertory: Prussia 1525 lists "offertory, secret, *canon minor* and *maior*" among the things "of necessity left out".
- **Remnants.** What remains is:
  - the secret's sung ending *Per omnia saecula saeculorum. Amen* (World without end. Amen) before the Preface (Müntzer (Radical Reformation), Lippe, Calenberg-Göttingen);
  - its name and place in Dortmund 1554, where the priest makes "an open prayer for all magistrates, estates and needs of the whole Christendom" instead;
  - collects for the Church and rulers said aloud under the Sanctus (Döber 1525, Brandenburg 1540, Calenberg-Göttingen 1542, Pfalz-Neuburg 1543).

4. The postcommunion: an ordinary prayer, but never only one (§5.6).

- **Luther's 1523 prayers.** They were kept in Latin as the priest's devotion (Brandenburg 1540, Pfalz-Neuburg 1543) and put into German as the *Complenda* (Strasbourg 1524, Moderate Reformed).
- **Proper postcommunions kept for a time.** Some orders kept the proper postcommunions of the Missal:
  - the Nürnberg parish Mass and Volprecht (1524), and Coburg 1524;
    - Müntzer (1524, Radical Reformation), with German versions of the Easter postcommunion *Spiritum nobis … tuae caritatis infunde* (Pour into us … the Spirit of thy love) and the Pentecost *Sancti Spiritus … infusio* (May the infusion of the Holy Spirit …);
  - Erfurt (1525), which adds the Trinity *Proficiat* (May [the receiving] profit);
  - **Calenberg-Göttingen 1542**, which prints, for each feast, Luther's thanksgiving followed by a proper postcommunion from the Missal (Advent *Suscipiamus*, Easter, Pentecost). This is the last order in the corpus to do so.
- **Luther's thanksgiving became the ordinary.** From the 1530s it is the standard Lutheran postcommunion, and some orders still call it "the complenda" (Hatzkerode, Reuss 1552, Breslau 1550).
- **The alternatives beside it.** Almost every order prints one or two alternatives, "or this":
  - the **Nürnberg thanksgiving of 1533** ("We give praise and thanks to thy divine bounty"), an expansion of *Quod ore sumpsimus*. Brandenburg 1540 and Pfalz-Neuburg 1543 sing it with Luther's "under one conclusion", as two collects;
  - a German version of the **Corpus Christi collect** *Deus, qui nobis sub sacramento mirabili* (O God, who under a wonderful sacrament) ("Ah thou dear Lord God, who in this wonderful sacrament …"): Mecklenburg 1545, Buxtehude 1565, Oldenburg 1573, Saxony and Mansfeld 1580, Grubenhagen 1581, Nördlingen 1579;
  - **Döber's prayer** of 1525, taken up by Mecklenburg;
  - Prussia 1544's second collect, sung on alternate Sundays.
- **Without communicants.** Where no one communicated, a free collect, or a "thanksgiving for the word of God heard" (Lippe 1571), took the postcommunion's place.

5. The Lenten prayer over the people: gone from the Mass, kept once in the office (§5.6.6).

- **Not at the Mass.** No order keeps the *oratio super populum* (prayer over the people) or its bidding *Humiliate capita vestra Deo* at the end of the Mass. The blessing "over the people" at the end of the Lutheran Mass is the Aaronic blessing.

- **At Lauds, in Ansbach.** The Brandenburg-Ansbach order for the collegiate churches (1533) strikes out the Lenten Lauds collects that "speak of the fast". In their place it allows "the *super populum* that followeth": the prayer over the people of the same day, which asks for God's protection without reference to fasting.

6. The overall pattern (§5.7).

- **Kept:** the collect of the day, mostly from the Missal; the shape *Dominus vobiscum* (The Lord be with you), *Oremus*, prayer and long conclusion, *Amen*; the idea of a closing prayer after the communion, still often called the *complenda* (completion).
- **Stripped:** the secret entirely; the Lenten *super populum* (over the people) at the Mass; the proper postcommunion (after a transition ending in 1542); commemorations of saints; the automatic multiplication of collects.
- **Added:** Luther's fixed thanksgiving; the Nürnberg thanksgiving; Dietrich's gospel collects; collects for rulers under the Sanctus; the peace collect at the end.
- **Altered:** Latin to German; the postcommunion from a proper to an ordinary, with alternatives; the sacrificial petitions of the old prayers recast as petitions for faith, love and the fruit of the sacrament.

5.2 Scope, sources and cautions

What was searched. The `eko.db` database was searched for the three prayers by name, in Latin, German and Low German spellings:

- *collecta*, *collecte*, *collecten* (collects), *oratio* (prayer), *gebet* (prayer);
- *secreta*, *secret*, *stillmesse* (silent Mass), *super oblata* (over the offerings);
- *complenda*, *complende* (completion), *postcommunio* (postcommunion), *post communionem* (after the communion), *danksagung* (thanksgiving), *danckseggínge* (thanksgiving);
- *super populum* (over the people), *super plebem* (over the people), *humiliate capita* (bow your heads), *inclinate capita* (incline your heads), "über das Volk" (over the people), "neiget eure Häupter" (bow your heads).

It was also searched for the opening words of the prayers that the orders use after the communion: *Quod ore sumpsimus* (What we have taken with our mouth), *Corpus tuum* (Thy body), *Proficiat* (May [the receiving] profit), "Wir danken dir … heilsame Gabe" (We give thanks to thee … salutary gift), "Wir sagen deiner göttlichen Mildigkeit" (We give … to thy divine bounty), "wunderbarlichen Sakrament" (wonderful sacrament), "heiligen Mut, guten Rat" (holy desires, good counsel). Sehling's editorial notes that identify Missal sources ("Röm. Meßbuch", "Missale", "lateinisches Meßgebet") were read for every order quoted. The passages were then read in context.

Related chapters. Three earlier chapters overlap with this one:

- Chapter 7 prints the eucharistic part of the early German Masses in full, including their offertory, Sanctus collects, thanksgivings and postcommunions. Where a text is printed there, this chapter cites it rather than repeating it.
- Chapter 4 deals with the other proper parts of the Mass: introit, lessons, gradual, offertory chant, Preface, communion chant.
- Chapter 8 deals with the hymns, including *Verleih uns Frieden*, after which the peace collect is sung.

Later chapters take up related subjects:

- Chapter 2 covers the salutation and collect in the order of the Mass, and the service when nobody communicated (§§2.8, 2.14).
- Chapter 6 covers the three collects read from the pulpit as a family of the general prayer (§6.15).
- Chapter 10 covers the collects of Matins and Vespers (§§10.7.1, 10.7.5).
- Chapter 13 covers the Litany and its collects (§13.21).
- Chapter 12 covers the seasons whose collects were kept (§12.12).

Where an order gives the collect to a deacon or junior minister, as at Hof, see Chapter 16.

Cautions. Four things limit what the corpus can show:

- **Silence is not absence.** Many orders say only "a collect" or "the collect with the blessing", without saying which. Where an order prints a collect series, it may not print the rubric for using it, and the reverse.
- **Sources of the German prayers.** The identification of a German prayer with a Latin one is in most cases Sehling's editors'. Where the identification is this chapter's own, it is marked as such. The German is often free.
- **The Missal used.** The editors cite the Roman Missal of their own day, or a diocesan Missal (Bamberg, Verden, Bremen, Magdeburg). The Latin texts given here are those of the Roman Missal. The Sarum Missal shares most of these collects and postcommunions with the Roman, though it numbers the Sundays after Trinity rather than after Pentecost. The German texts therefore cannot show whether a prayer came by a Sarum or a Roman route; in the German lands the source was in any case the local diocesan Missal.
- **Beyond the corpus.** The corpus ends in the early seventeenth century. It says nothing directly about the later Lutheran service books, including the Common Service and its postcommunions. §5.6.2 notes the points of contact.

5.3 The medieval system and Luther's rulings

5.3.1 What the reformers inherited

The three prayers. In the late-medieval Mass the celebrant said three variable prayers, each ending with the long conclusion (*Per Dominum nostrum* …, Through our Lord …):

- the **collect** after the Gloria, sung aloud;
- the **secret** at the end of the offertory, said silently over the bread and wine, of which only the closing *Per omnia saecula saeculorum* (World without end) was sung aloud, as the opening of the Preface dialogue;
- the **postcommunion** or *complenda* (completion) after the communion, sung aloud.

Proper and multiplied. All three changed with the day. They were also added to. Commemorations of a feast falling on the same day, of an octave, or of a season brought their own collect, secret and postcommunion. Votive prayers (for peace, for the ruler, for rain or fair weather) were added in the same way. Sehling's editors gloss the terms where the orders use them: the *complenda* is "the closing collect" (Sehling 20/1, p. 123, n. 29) and "today called the postcommunion" (Sehling 11, p. 49, n. 24).

5.3.2 Luther's *Formula missae*, 1523: one collect, no secret, a new postcommunion

"Hireling collects." Luther's preface to the *Formula missae* (Form of the Mass) lists the collects among the late accretions that made the Mass a sacrifice. **Luther, *Formula missae et communionis*, 1523** (Sehling 1, p. 4):

there the Mass began to be made a sacrifice; there were added the offertories and the hireling collects; there the sequences and proses were inserted between the Sanctus and the Gloria in excelsis.

The collect: kept, but only one. The collect of the day is kept, "if only it be godly", and Luther notes that the Sunday collects mostly are. But it is to be said alone: no commemorations, no second or third collect. **Luther, *Formula missae et communionis*, 1523** (Sehling 1, p. 5):

Thirdly, the prayer or collect which followeth, if only it be godly (as for the most part are those which are appointed for the Lord's days), let it continue in its accustomed rite, but that one alone. After this the reading of the epistle.

The secret: gone with the offertory. Luther rejects the whole offertory, "whence also it is called the offertory", because from there on "almost everything soundeth and savoureth of oblation" (Sehling 1, p. 5). The secret, the prayer over the oblation, falls with it. The text and the details are given in Chapter 7, §7.3.1.

The postcommunion: the proper *complenda* replaced. The proper postcommunions are rejected for the same reason: "they almost all sound of sacrifice". In their place Luther puts two of the priest's private prayers from the ablutions, said aloud in the collect tone. **Luther, *Formula missae et communionis*, 1523** (Sehling 1, p. 6):

But in the place of the complenda or last collect, because they almost all sound of sacrifice, let that prayer be read in the same tone: "What we have taken with our mouth, O Lord". That other also may be read: "Thy body, O Lord, which we have received, etc.", the number being changed into the plural.

The two prayers are:

- ***Quod ore sumpsimus***: "What we have taken with our mouth, O Lord, may we receive with a pure mind; and from a temporal gift may it become for us an everlasting remedy."
- ***Corpus tuum***: "Thy Body, O Lord, which I have taken, and thy Blood, which I have drunk, cleave unto my inmost parts …"

What this did to the system. In one stroke the *Formula missae* reduced the three proper prayers to one. The collect stayed proper. The secret was gone. The postcommunion became, for the first time, an **ordinary**: the same prayer every Sunday.

5.3.3 Luther's *Deutsche Messe*, 1526: one collect and a fixed thanksgiving

The collect. The *Deutsche Messe* (German Mass) gives one collect, read by the priest "facing the altar" on a fixed pitch. The example printed is a German collect from the Missal. **Luther, *Deutsche Messe und ordnung gottis diensts*, 1526** (Sehling 1, p. 14):

Thereafter the priest readeth a collect on F fa ut in unison, as followeth: Almighty God, who art the protector of all that hope in thee, without whose grace no man is able to do aught, nor is anything of worth before thee; let thy mercy richly come upon us, that by thy holy inspiration we may think those things that be right, and by thy power also perform the same; for Jesus Christ our Lord's sake. Amen.

Its source. The first half is the collect "O God, the protector of all that trust in thee, without whom nothing is strong, nothing is holy, multiply upon us thy mercy" (third Sunday after Pentecost, the fourth after Trinity). The editors of the Lüneburg order identify the Missal prayer (Sehling 6/1, p. 572, n. 70). The second half follows, in this chapter's reading, the Rogate collect "O God, from whom all good things do come … that we may think, by thy inspiration, those things that be right, and by thy guiding may perform the same". The *Deutsche Messe* collect thus fuses two Missal collects into one German prayer.

The postcommunion: a single fixed thanksgiving. After the communion the *Deutsche Messe* has one prayer, with no alternative, followed by the Aaronic blessing. **Luther, *Deutsche Messe und ordnung gottis diensts*, 1526** (Sehling 1, p. 16):

Thereafter followeth the collect with the blessing. We give thanks unto thee, Almighty Lord God, that thou hast refreshed us through this salutary gift; and we beseech thy mercy, that thou wouldest make the same to prosper in us unto strong faith toward thee and unto fervent love among us all; for Jesus Christ our Lord's sake. Amen.

Its source. This is not a new composition but an old postcommunion, recast. The editor of the Verden order of 1606 points to P. Drews, who traced it to the postcommunion of the eighteenth Sunday after Pentecost. **Verden, *Kirchenordnung*, 1606, editor's note** (Sehling 7/1, p. 161, n. 81):

on the Latin origin of the collect (the postcommunion of the Mass of the eighteenth Sunday after Pentecost in the Missal): P. Drews, *Beiträge zu Luthers liturgischen Reformen*, 1910, pp. 95f.

The Latin reads: "We give thee thanks, O Lord, being quickened by the sacred gift, beseeching thy mercy that thou wouldest make us worthy of the partaking thereof." Luther kept the frame ("we give thanks … refreshed by the gift … we beseech thy mercy"). He changed the petition: not that we be made **worthy** of the sacrament, but that it **prosper in us** unto faith toward God and love toward one another.

The result. One proper postcommunion of the year, made over, became the fixed postcommunion of the *Deutsche Messe*. Through the Saxon and Low German orders it became the ordinary Lutheran postcommunion (§5.6.3).

5.4 The collect

5.4.1 One collect, or two

Luther's rule: one. The *Formula missae* (Form of the Mass) allowed "that one alone" (§5.3.2). The early Nürnberg Masses follow it:

- **Volprecht's Mass, 1524**, lists the parts of the Mass with what is "always said" and "never said". Of the collect it says: "only one is said". **Nürnberg, *Deutsche Messe des Priors Volprecht*, 1524** (Sehling 11, p. 39):

Gloria in excelsis Deo is always said. Collect: one only is said. Epistle, gradual, verse, Alleluia, verse.

- **The Nürnberg parish churches, 1524**: "the celebrant sings the Sunday prayer, *Sancti tui nominis* etc." (Sehling 11, p. 46). Sehling's note explains: "the prayer falling on the Sunday in question (the collect)".

The memorial collect survives as a prayer "for need". Mecklenburg 1545 keeps Luther's rule but leaves room for a second collect in time of need. It also forbids reading the same collect every time, and reading a collect out of its season. **Mecklenburg, *Ordeninge der misse*, 1545** (Sehling 5, p. 152):

One shall also read but one collect at a time, unless it were that some other great need were at hand which required yet another prayer. Each shall order the prayers according to the occasion, that not always the same collect be read; nor at the feast of Easter the collects of Christmas; but [each shall] deal herein in order, as becometh faithful stewards.

Two collects as the rule: Ansbach 1548. The Ansbach *Auctuarium* of 1548, an Interim order, goes back to the medieval pattern of a collect of the day followed by a second, votive collect. It requires two, and fixes their subjects: the first for spiritual things, the second for temporal goods. **Brandenburg-Ansbach-Kulmbach, *Auctuarium*, 1548** (Interim order; Sehling 11, p. 330):

After such singing there follow in the church order very many collects or prayers set forth, out of which each time two collects shall be taken according to the occasion of the time, for all manner of concerns of Christendom and of the people; yet so that the first collect be always for spiritual things, and the second for temporal goods, as peace, good weather, for the fruit of the field, etc., altogether as is set forth in the church order.

"One or more." Other orders leave the number open:

- **Henneberg**: a pastor's report has "a collect or two, as need requireth" after the sermon (Sehling 2, p. 330).
- **Wolfstein 1574**: "one or more collects according to the occasion of the time etc., and these shall be in German and not Latin" (Sehling 13, p. 576).

The second collect for peace. The commonest second prayer is the collect for peace. Luther's *Verleih uns Frieden* (Grant us peace) was sung at the end of the service with a German collect after it, "Lord God, heavenly Father, who workest holy desires, good counsel and right works …". This is the Missal collect of the Mass for peace, *Deus, a quo sancta desideria, recta consilia, et iusta sunt opera* (O God, from whom all holy desires, all good counsels and all just works do proceed; Sehling 6/2, p. 819, n. 71). It appears in at least twelve orders of the corpus, from Saxony 1539 to Schaumburg 1614. In Calenberg-Göttingen 1542 it follows the proper postcommunion, so that the Advent Mass ends with two collects, the proper one and the one for peace (§5.6.2).

Hof 1592: "of the season, or for rain". At Vespers the Hof deacon sings "the collect of the season, or also for rain and fair weather" (Sehling 11, p. 429). The votive collects *ad petendam pluviam* (for asking rain) and *ad poscendam serenitatem* (for asking fair weather) of the Missal survive here by name.

5.4.2 The collect of the day kept, in German

Saxony 1539. The order of Duke Henry has the collect "in Latin or German, the common one or *quotidianam*, or *de festis*, as they stand hereafter at the end". **Saxony, *Kirchenordnunge zum anfang*, 1539** (Sehling 1, p. 274):

Thereafter a collect, also in Latin or German, the common one or [the] daily one, or [one] of the feasts, as they stand hereafter at the end.

The collects at the end are headed "collects or prayers which one may read in the church under the office of the Mass (before the epistle) and also otherwise" (Sehling 1, p. 275). They are grouped by season: Advent, Christmas, and so on.

Collect series by the church year. The later territorial orders print a series of German collects for the seasons and feasts:

- **Saxony 1580** and **Mansfeld 1580** (Sehling 1, p. 375; 2, pp. 227–229);
- **Lüneburg 1564** and **Wolfenbüttel 1569** (Sehling 6/1, pp. 568–572 and 178–179);
- **Henneberg 1582** (Sehling 2, p. 317);
- **Grubenhagen 1581** (Sehling 6/2, pp. 1076–1081);
- **Verden 1606** and **Osnabrück 1618** (Sehling 7/1), **Oldenburg 1573** (Sehling 7/2.1) and **Schaumburg 1614** (Sehling 7/2.2).

Henneberg introduces its series as "pure collects", partly in use before, partly new. **Henneberg, *Kirchen ordnung* of Georg Ernst, 1582** (Sehling 2, p. 317):

Here follow the collects, according to the order of the seasons and feasts in the year. That the pastors and ministers of the church may have the versicles and pure collects together, it hath been thought good to set them down hereafter. And such have for a good part been in use in our churches heretofore also, except some which have been newly added, partly by occasion of this order and partly otherwise; and first those [appointed] for certain feasts and seasons, then other common ones, which are wont to be sung according to the occasion of every need that falleth out, and otherwise.

The proper collect kept with its versicle. Henneberg's "versicles and pure collects" keep another medieval habit: the collect introduced by a seasonal versicle. Its Advent set begins "Prepare ye the way of the Lord, alleluia" (Sehling 2, p. 317). Hof 1592 does the same before its festal collects ("Unto us a child is born", Sehling 11, p. 413).

What the German collects are. Sehling's editors trace most of the seasonal collects of the Saxon and Lower Saxon series back to the **Wittenberg hymnbook of 1533**, and through it to the Missal. Lüneburg's Advent collect is a typical case. **Lüneburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1564** (Sehling 6/1, pp. 542–543):

Thereupon let the priest turn again toward the altar and sing a collect of the season or of the feast, or one that agreeth with the matter, to the following melody: […] Let us pray. Almighty Lord God, stir us up, that we may be ready, when thy Son cometh, to receive him with joy and to serve thee with a pure heart; through the same thy Son Jesus Christ our Lord.

This is the Advent collect "Stir up our hearts, O Lord, to make ready the ways of thine only-begotten Son, that by his coming we may be worthy to serve thee with purified minds". Sehling's editors identify it as the collect of the second Sunday in Advent (Sehling 6/2, p. 1077, n. 86; 7/1, p. 93, n. 7). "to serve with a pure heart" is *purificatis mentibus servire* (to serve with purified minds). The Missal's "prepare the ways of thine Only-begotten" becomes "that we may be ready … to receive him with joy". The same collect stands in Saxony 1580, Mansfeld 1580, Grubenhagen 1581, Buxtehude 1565 and Ysenburg-Birstein 1588.

Other Missal collects identified by the editors. In the notes to Lüneburg, Grubenhagen, Osnabrück and Oldenburg the editors identify, among others:

- Christmas: "Grant, we beseech thee, almighty God, that the new birth in the flesh of thine Only-begotten may set us free" (third Mass of Christmas; Sehling 7/1, p. 271; 7/2.1, p. 1134);
- Ascension: "Grant, we beseech thee, almighty God, that we who believe thine only-begotten Son … to have ascended this day into the heavens" (Sehling 6/2, p. 1078, n. 97);
- Pentecost: "O God, who on this day didst teach the hearts of the faithful by the light of the Holy Spirit" (Sehling 6/2, p. 1079, n. 99);
- the third Sunday after Easter (Sehling 6/1, p. 573, n. 76).

Pentecost is identified in Osnabrück too (Sehling 7/1, p. 275). The introduction to the Oldenburg order sums up its very large collection: of all its collects only two are its own, and of these "the one rests upon a Latin Mass prayer" (Sehling 7/2.1, p. 962).

5.4.3 The collects purged

"If it be pure." The condition Luther set ("if only it be godly") recurs:

- **Amberg 1550**: "the collect of the season, if it be pure, and the epistle in Latin" (Sehling 13, p. 286).
- **Henneberg 1582**: "pure collects" (above).

Collects removed. The collects that went were those of the saints, and above all those that asked for the intercession of Mary and the saints. Hannover 1536 names them with the Marian antiphons. **Hannover, *Kirchenordnung*, 1536** (Sehling 6/2, p. 1009):

Whatsoever is against God's word we will never suffer to be sung or read, be it German or Latin. Therefore we have put away the Salve regina, the Regina caeli, the Sub tuum praesidium, and certain collects wherein the honour that belongeth to our one Mediator Jesus Christ alone is all too grossly given to the creatures.

Luther on the office collects. Already in 1523 Luther had set aside the antiphons, responsories and collects "of the saints and of the cross" until "they be swept", "for there is grievous much filth therein" (Sehling 1, p. 3).

5.4.4 New collects added: the gospel collects

Veit Dietrich's collects. The chief addition was a new kind of collect: one written on the **gospel of the day**, as a summary of the sermon, rather than on the season. The source was Veit Dietrich's *Kinderpostille* and *Summarien* (from 1546). Wolfenbüttel 1569 allows them in place of the season's collect. **Wolfenbüttel, *Kirchenordnung*, 1569** (Sehling 6/1, p. 179):

There may also at times on the Sundays and holy days the collects be accommodated to the doctrine that is handled out of the gospel, as such collects are to be found in the children's postil of Veit Dietrich.

Other orders allow the same:

- **Lippe, Corvinus's order of 1542**: a later hand adds that "there stand also certain fine collects in the postil of Veit Dietrich, appointed for all Sundays and feasts" (Sehling 21, p. 352, apparatus).
- **Soest 1609**: "a collect … that agreeth with the gospel, or else a common collect for the grace of the Holy Ghost for the sermon" (Sehling 22, p. 488).
- **Lüneburg 1564**: "or one that agreeth with the matter" (above).

Two collects again: one before and one after the sermon. In the Buxtehude agenda of 1565 each Sunday has two collects, the old and the new. Sehling's introduction describes the arrangement. **Buxtehude, *Agende*, 1565, editor's introduction** (Sehling 7/1, p. 67):

In the first collection of collects for the Sundays and feasts of the year there alternate for the most part a prayer borrowed from the Missal (rendered, indeed, into Low German and in part very freely) and a gospel collect of Veit Dietrich, the one prayer to be said before the sermon and the other after it. Underlying this cycle of collects is a collection by the Mansfeld court preacher Michael Coelius (1492–1559), which appeared in various editions. A second collection of collects toward the end of the agenda brings together old Latin Mass prayers, here and there somewhat revised.

An example of the Missal collect "before the sermon" is that of the third Sunday after Epiphany, "Almighty and everlasting God, mercifully look upon our infirmity, and stretch forth the right hand of thy majesty to protect us". Sehling's note cites the Verden Missal for it (Sehling 7/1, p. 98, n. 62). **Buxtehude, *Agende*, 1565** (Sehling 7/1, p. 98):

On the third Sunday. Prayer before the sermon. Almighty Lord God, mayest thou graciously take to heart our weakness, and stretch forth thy mighty hand to defend us against our enemies; through Jesus Christ our Lord. Amen.

Michael Coelius. The editors name the source of many of these German Missal collects: the collection of the Mansfeld court preacher **Michael Coelius**, who "translated a Latin Mass prayer into German for his collection of collects" (Sehling 7/2.1, p. 1137, n. 35; 7/1, p. 92, n. 1). The old proper collects thus came into the Lutheran orders by two routes. The first was Luther's circle and the Wittenberg hymnbooks (1529–1533). The second was Coelius's translations.

5.4.5 Language, voice and form

Latin or German. The early orders allowed either:

- **Bremen 1534**: "a collect in Latin out of the Mass book, or in German out of the hymnbook" (Sehling 7/2.2, p. 459);
- **Saxony 1539**: "also in Latin or German" (above);
- **Amberg 1550**: the collect of the season, in Latin (above).

Later orders required German, so that the people could say the Amen. **Coburg, *Vorschaffung* of the visitation of 1554/55** (Sehling 1, p. 544):

Thirdly, that no collects be sung in Latin, but all together in German, that the people may understand, and sing Amen thereto.

Wolfstein 1574 says the same ("in German and not Latin", Sehling 13, p. 576). Mecklenburg 1545 has the collect read "with a loud voice, that the whole church may say Amen and so cry unto God with the priest" (Sehling 5, p. 152).

Facing the altar. Luther's *Deutsche Messe* (German Mass) has the collect read "with the face turned to the altar", the epistle "with the face turned to the people" (Sehling 1, p. 14). Lüneburg 1564 keeps the rule (above). Hof 1592 has the deacon sing the collect "facing the people" (*spectans populum*, Sehling 11, p. 425).

The conclusions. Hof 1592 keeps the medieval rules for ending a collect, set out as in the old rubrics. **Hof, *Ordo ecclesiasticus*, 1592** (Sehling 11, p. 411):

A note on the collects! Whensoever the prayer is directed to the Father alone, let there be said at the end: Through our Lord Jesus Christ, etc. But if it be directed to the Father, and mention of the Son be made in it, let there be said at the end: through the same our Lord Jesus Christ. If the prayer be directed to the Son alone, let the ending be formed thus: Who with the Father and the Holy Ghost livest and reignest, God, world without end, etc.

Hof's collects at Mass. At the Mass itself Hof's deacon sings "the collect of the season, or one directed to the Lord's Supper". After the communion he sings "a collect, for example the thanksgiving for the Lord's Supper received" (Sehling 11, pp. 425–426). Its example of a Mass collect is the *Deutsche Messe* collect "O almighty God, who art a protector of all" (Sehling 11, p. 425).

5.5 The secret

5.5.1 Abolished with the offertory

No order keeps the secret as a prayer over the gifts. The secret was the offertory's own prayer: it asked God to receive the gifts offered. Luther's rejection of the offertory (§5.3.2) took it with it, and the orders that name the secret do so only to say it is left out:

- **Volprecht, 1524**: "the offertory is never said, because Christ was once offered for our sins" (Sehling 11, p. 39). There is no secret in his list.
- **The Nürnberg parish Mass, 1524**: after the Creed the celebrant goes straight to *Dominus vobiscum* (The Lord be with you) and *Sursum corda* (Lift up your hearts), "the offertory and the lesser canon being omitted" (Sehling 11, p. 47).
- **Prussia 1525** names the secret outright. **Prussia, *Artikel der ceremonien und anderer kirchenordnung*, 1525** (Sehling 4, p. 32):

There followeth the Preface, which the priest singeth in German, together with the evangelical words of the blessing or consecration of bread and wine (for the offertory, the secret, the lesser and the greater canon are of necessity left out).

Never a German secret. The Lutheran orders translated collects and postcommunions from the Missal, but the corpus has no German version of any secret. The secrets were the prayers that most plainly asked God to accept an offering. Unlike the collects, they could not be "purified" by a light change of wording.

5.5.2 What took the secret's place

Its last words. The secret ended aloud with *Per omnia saecula saeculorum. Amen* (World without end. Amen), which ran straight into *Dominus vobiscum* (The Lord be with you) and *Sursum corda* (Lift up your hearts). Three German Masses keep this ending before the Preface dialogue, though the silent prayer is gone:

- Müntzer (Radical Reformation): "through all eternity of eternity. Amen";
- Lippe: "Through all eternity of eternity, amen";
- Calenberg-Göttingen 1542: "God be praised from eternity to eternity. Amen".

See Chapter 7, §7.1.1 and §7.4.1.

An open prayer at the same place. Dortmund 1554 keeps the heading *Secreta* and says what is to be done there instead. The silent prayer over the gifts becomes an open prayer for the magistrates and the needs of Christendom, if the general prayer has not already been said after the sermon. **Dortmund, *Gottesdienstordnung*, 1554** (Sehling 21, p. 209):

Secret. In place of the Secret the priest may make an open prayer for all magistrates, estates and needs of the whole Christendom, wherewith he may come to the Preface, if he have not made the common prayer after the sermon; or else another, according to the occasion of the time.

Collects under the Sanctus. In several orders the space between the offertory and the Verba was filled with **collects said aloud** for the Church and the magistrates. They stood under the Sanctus, before or after the Verba:

- **Döber, Nürnberg 1525**: an optional "common prayer, to be said on a holy day when there is much people, after the Preface or before the Sanctus, as one will" (Sehling 11, p. 55). See Chapter 7, §7.8.11.
- **Brandenburg 1540**: four German collects under the Latin Sanctus (§7.12.2 of that chapter).

- **Calenberg-Göttingen 1542**: "the collect which the priest prayeth under the Sanctus", headed "For the magistrates". It is printed in every proper Mass of the order: "There follow the collects which the priest prayeth under the Sanctus: Merciful heavenly Father …" (Sehling 6/2, p. 819, and again in each proper Mass, pp. 821–833). See §7.13.1 of that chapter.
- **Pfalz-Neuburg 1543**: three collects under the Sanctus, after the Verba (§7.14.4 of that chapter).

These are not secrets. They are not proper to the day, they say nothing of gifts, and they are said aloud. But they occupy the secret's place, and like the medieval memorial collects they pray for the ruler and for peace.

A prayer over the gifts, once. Only Pfalz-Neuburg 1543 has a prayer said over the bread and wine before the Verba: Osiander's "We bring … these thy gifts". It is a new composition, not a secret. See Chapter 7, §7.14.2.

In sum. Of the three proper prayers the secret alone vanished without a successor of its own kind. What survives is its closing doxology, its place (filled with intercessions), and in one order its name.

5.6 The postcommunion

5.6.1 Luther's 1523 substitutes: *Quod ore sumpsimus* and *Corpus tuum*

In Latin. Brandenburg 1540 and Pfalz-Neuburg 1543 keep both of Luther's prayers in Latin. The priest says them "bowing", after the German thanksgiving (Sehling 3, p. 70; 13, p. 76). The texts are given in Chapter 7, §7.12.8 and §7.14.8. Here they have become the priest's own devotion again, said after the people's thanksgiving, which is what they had been in the Roman rite.

In German. The Strasbourg Mass of Theobald Schwarz (1524, Moderate Reformed) gives *Quod ore sumpsimus* (What we have taken with our mouth) in German under the old name *Complenda*. It also allows "any other that seemeth Christian". **Strasbourg, the early agendas: Schwarz's German Mass, 1524** (Moderate Reformed; Sehling 20/1, p. 123):

Complenda. Let us pray. What we have taken with our mouth, grant us, O Lord, that we may receive the same with a pure mind; and that from the temporal gift there may be made unto us an everlasting medicine; through Christ Jesus our Lord. Amen. Or some other that seemeth Christian.

The printed *Teutsche Meß* (German Mass) of 1524 has the same text (Sehling 20/1, p. 133). The Strasbourg *Ordenung und inhalt Teutscher Mess* (Order and content of the German Mass; also Moderate Reformed) explains the term for the people: "Complenda: the conclusion with a common prayer" (Sehling 20/1, p. 135). Volprecht's German Mass has a German *Quod ore* (What with our mouth) too (Chapter 7, §7.7.2).

5.6.2 Proper postcommunions kept

Not every early order followed Luther. Several kept the proper *complenda* (completion) of the day, either in Latin or in a German version.

Nürnberg, 1524. The Latin Mass of the Nürnberg parish churches ends with the day's postcommunion. **Nürnberg, *Gottesdienstordnung der Pfarrkirchen*, 1524** (Sehling 11, p. 49):

Finally let the office be concluded with the prayer which they call the complenda.

The Coburg proposal of 1524, which follows the Nürnberg Mass ("the offertory and the lesser canon left out"), likewise ends with "the collect which they call the complenda, and the Benedicamus with the blessing, as is customary" (Sehling 1, p. 542).

Volprecht, 1524. Volprecht's outline of the Latin Mass has "the postcommunion of whatever Mass is being said" (Sehling 11, p. 39). Sehling's note: "namely the one falling due in each case". His German Mass for Trinity ends with the Trinity postcommunion, *Proficiat nobis ad salutem corporis et animae* (May [the receiving] profit us for the health of body and soul), in German (Sehling 11, p. 42). See Chapter 7, §7.7.2.

Müntzer, 1524 (Radical Reformation). Each of Müntzer's five German Masses ends with a "prayer at the end of the office", most of them German versions of the Missal postcommunion. For Easter it is the Easter postcommunion, "Pour into us, O Lord, the Spirit of thy love, that those whom thou hast filled with the paschal sacraments thou mayest make to be of one mind by thy goodness". **Allstedt, Thomas Müntzer, *Deutsch evangelisch messe*, 1524** (Radical Reformation; Sehling 1, p. 503):

Christ our Passover is sacrificed for us, alleluia, alleluia. […] Prayer at the end of the office of the Resurrection. O Lord, pour into us the spirit of love, and those whom thou hast filled with thine Easter lamb make of one mind in thy love; through Jesus, etc.

The other postcommunions of Müntzer's Masses (Radical Reformation):

- **Pentecost**: *Sancti Spiritus, Domine, corda nostra mundet infusio* ("O Lord, grant us the grace of the Holy Ghost, that the dew of thy goodness …", Sehling 1, p. 504).
- **Advent**: a new prayer, "O Lord God, stand hard by us" (Chapter 7, §7.4.4).
- **Christmas and the Passion**: prayers in the same form, "O gracious God, open unto us the abyss of our souls …" and "O Lord, give thy poor people to know thy fatherly chastening and rod …" (Sehling 1, p. 502). This chapter has not found a Missal source for them.

Erfurt, 1525. The Erfurt *Deutsches Kirchenamt* (German church office) takes over the offices of Müntzer (Radical Reformation) and adds one for Trinity. Its "prayer at the end of the office" is the Trinity postcommunion *Proficiat* (May [the receiving] profit). **Erfurt, *Deutsches Kirchenamt*, 1525** (Sehling 2, p. 378):

Prayer at the end of the office: O Lord God, let the receiving of the holy sacrament profit us for body and soul, and the everlasting confession of the holy and self-subsistent, undivided Trinity. Who livest and reignest, God, with the Son and the Holy Ghost, from everlasting to everlasting. Amen.

The Latin reads: "May the receiving of this sacrament, O Lord our God, profit us for the health of body and soul, and the everlasting confession of the holy Trinity and of its undivided Unity". Erfurt's Pentecost office has Müntzer's Pentecost postcommunion (Sehling 2, p. 377).

Calenberg-Göttingen, 1542. The fullest survival is in the Calenberg-Göttingen order. Its proper Masses for Advent, Christmas, Purification, the Passion, Easter, Ascension and Pentecost each have, in order:

1. the collect of the day after the Gloria;
2. a collect for the magistrates under the Sanctus (§5.5.2);
3. in every Mass but Advent, a fixed thanksgiving after the communion ("The thanksgiving"), usually Luther's;
4. after the *Agnus Dei* (Lamb of God), a second, **proper** postcommunion, headed "The collect". Some are Missal postcommunions, others collects from the Wittenberg hymnbook (Passion, Sehling 6/2, p. 827).

Sehling's editors identify several of these proper prayers as Missal postcommunions. The Advent Mass, which has no thanksgiving, ends with the proper postcommunion and then the *Da pacem* (Give peace) with its collect: two collects after the communion, the proper one and the one for peace, as in the medieval rite. **Calenberg-Göttingen, *Kirchenordnung*, 1542, Advent** (Sehling 6/2, p. 819):

Collect. Lord, let us receive thy mercy in the midst of thy temple, that we may go before the glory which shall come upon us at that day with fitting honour. The *Da pacem* for the conclusion: […] Grant us peace graciously, Lord God, in our days; there is indeed none other that could fight for us but thou, our God, alone. God, give peace in thy land! Fortune and welfare to every estate! Lord God, heavenly Father, who workest holy desire, good counsel and right works, give unto thy servants peace, which the world cannot give, that our hearts may cleave to thy commandments, and that we may pass our time by thy defence quiet and safe from enemies; through Jesus Christ, thy Son, our Lord. Amen.

The first prayer is the postcommunion of the first Sunday in Advent: "We have received thy mercy, O Lord, in the midst of thy temple, that we may go before the coming solemnities of our restoration with due honours". Sehling's note gives the Latin phrase *in medio templi tui* (in the midst of thy temple) (Sehling 6/2, p. 819, nn. 69–69a). The German changes "the coming solemnities of our redemption" into "the glory which shall come upon us at that day", turning the prayer from Christmas to the Last Day. The peace collect is the Missal's *Deus, a quo sancta desideria* (O God, from whom [all] holy desires; n. 71).

The Easter Mass of the same order has, after Luther's thanksgiving and the *Agnus Dei*, a version of the Easter postcommunion. It is shorter and freer than Müntzer's. **Calenberg-Göttingen, *Kirchenordnung*, 1542, Easter** (Sehling 6/2, p. 829):

The thanksgiving. We give thanks unto thee, Almighty God … […] The Agnus Dei. O Lamb of God, unspotted … […] Lord, pour out upon us thy Spirit, that we may live in constant love and concord, and never forget thy resurrection and thy coming again. Amen. The blessing. The Lord bless thee …

Sehling's note: "On the following prayer compare the Roman Missal … (postcommunion on Easter Sunday and Easter Monday)" (Sehling 6/2, p. 829, n. 37a). The order's Pentecost Mass has the Pentecost postcommunion of Müntzer (Radical Reformation) in the same place (Sehling 6/2, p. 834). The order's common Mass, used outside the feasts, has in this slot the priest's prayer for peace *Domine Iesu Christe, qui dixisti* (O Lord Jesus Christ, who saidst) in German. See Chapter 7, §7.13.3.

Where the line ends. Calenberg-Göttingen 1542 is the last order in the corpus to print proper postcommunions for the feasts. After it the proper postcommunion is gone from the Mass. Some of these prayers survived as collects for other uses: the Corpus Christi collect became an alternative postcommunion (§5.6.4), and the Easter prayer for love and concord passed into the German collect books.

A note on the Common Service. The modern Common Service tradition, with its Sarum-derived postcommunion beside Luther's, lies outside the corpus, which ends in the early seventeenth century. Two things in the corpus bear on it:

- The **Easter postcommunion *Spiritum nobis … tuae caritatis infunde*** is one of the Missal postcommunions that evangelical orders put into German and used after the communion: first Müntzer (Radical Reformation), then the Lutheran Calenberg-Göttingen.
- The Sarum and Roman Missals share most of their collects and postcommunions. The corpus therefore cannot show whether a given prayer reached a later book from the Sarum or the Roman Missal. The German orders took theirs from the German diocesan Missals.

5.6.3 Luther's thanksgiving becomes the ordinary postcommunion

From 1526 on. Luther's thanksgiving "We give thanks to thee, almighty Lord God, that thou hast refreshed us through this salutary gift" (§5.3.3) became the standard postcommunion of the Lutheran orders. The editor of the Verden order lists where it stands (Sehling 7/1, p. 161, n. 81):

- Lüneburg and Wolfenbüttel;
- Lippe, Spiegelberg and Pyrmont 1571;
- Oldenburg 1573;
- Grubenhagen and Hoya 1581;
- Lauenburg;
- Osnabrück 1618;
- and, he adds, "elsewhere also widely spread".

To these the corpus adds Saxony 1539 and 1580, Mansfeld 1580, Prussia 1544, Mecklenburg 1545, Calenberg-Göttingen 1542, Brandenburg 1540, Pfalz-Neuburg 1543, Hatzkerode, Nördlingen 1579 and others.

Still called the *complenda*. Some orders keep the old name for the new prayer. The Hatzkerode order calls Luther's thanksgiving "the complenda". **Hatzkerode, *Kirchenordnunge*, 1534(?)** (Sehling 2, p. 587):

he shall turn about and sing the salutation, The Lord be with you; then, turned again to the altar, the complenda: We give thanks unto thee, etc., or the like; and last he shall turn about again and sing the blessing, The Lord bless thee, etc.

The term occurs also in Reuss 1552 ("the complenda after the use of our church … which one singeth toward the people", Sehling 2, p. 154), in Breslau 1550 ("then one readeth the complenda", Sehling 3, p. 404) and in the Wendish service at Senftenberg 1555 ("together with the complenda and the Aaronic blessing", Sehling 1, p. 672). Other orders call it simply "a collect of thanksgiving" (Schleswig-Holstein 1542, Sehling 23, p. 91).

The salutation and the "Let us give thanks". The thanksgiving keeps the frame of the old postcommunion: *Dominus vobiscum* (The Lord be with you), *Oremus*, the prayer, *Amen*. Two orders add a bidding to give thanks:

- **Mecklenburg 1545**: "Give thanks unto the Lord. Thereupon the church answereth: To God be praise and thanks" (Sehling 5, p. 155);
- **Saxony 1580**: "Let us give thanks unto the Lord and pray" (below).

Nördlingen 1579 puts a **versicle** before each, as before a medieval collect: 1 Cor 11:26 ("As often as ye eat this bread …") before Luther's thanksgiving, and 1 Cor 11:27 before the alternative. It appoints them for Palm Sunday and Maundy Thursday, "and also all Sundays and holy days after the communion held" (Sehling 12, p. 382).

5.6.4 The alternatives

The ordinary was not alone. Most orders print Luther's thanksgiving with one or two alternatives, "or this". The alternatives come from four sources.

(a) The Nürnberg thanksgiving of 1533. Brandenburg-Nürnberg 1533 orders "a common prayer in German, spoken openly", which "shall be a thanksgiving". It is a new composition, longer than Luther's, and asks that what was received with the mouth be grasped by faith. **Brandenburg-Nürnberg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1533** (Sehling 11, p. 197):

Now when all the people have been communicated, there shall again be spoken openly a common prayer in German. This shall be a thanksgiving, thus: Let us pray. O almighty, everlasting God, we give praise and thanks unto thy divine bounty, that thou hast fed us and given us to drink with the wholesome flesh and blood of thine only Son Jesus Christ our Lord; and we humbly beseech thee that thou wouldest work in us by thy Holy Ghost, that as we have received this holy sacrament with the mouth, so we may also with firm faith lay hold on and for ever retain thy divine grace, forgiveness of sins, union with Christ and everlasting life, which are therein shown forth and promised. Through our Lord Jesus Christ, thy Son, who with thee in the unity of the Holy Ghost liveth and reigneth, true God, ever and everlastingly. Amen.

The phrase "as we have received … with the mouth, so … with firm faith" is Luther's *Quod ore sumpsimus … pura mente capiamus* (What we have taken with our mouth … may we receive with a pure mind) opened out. The 1533 prayer is thus the third stage of the 1523 substitute: Latin ablution prayer, then plain German, then a doctrinal expansion.

(b) Two collects "under one conclusion". Brandenburg 1540 joins the Nürnberg prayer and Luther's into a single "thanksgiving" (Sehling 3, p. 70). Pfalz-Neuburg 1543 does the same and names the old technique: two collects sung "under one conclusion", the way the medieval rite joined a postcommunion and a commemoration. **Pfalz-Neuburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1543** (Sehling 13, p. 76):

Thereafter he shall sing these two collects under one conclusion in the accustomed tone, or say them with an audible voice. Let us pray. O almighty, everlasting God, we give praise and thanks unto thy divine bounty, that thou hast fed us and given us to drink with the wholesome flesh and blood of thine only Son Jesus Christ our Lord […]. Another prayer. We thank thee also, Lord Jesus Christ, that thou hast refreshed us through this salutary gift of thy body and blood; and we beseech thy mercy that thou wouldest make the same to prosper in us unto a strong faith toward thee and unto fervent love among us all; who with God the Father in the unity of the Holy Ghost livest and reignest ever and everlastingly. Choir: Amen.

Pfalz-Neuburg addresses Luther's prayer to **Christ** ("Lord Jesus Christ") and closes it with the conclusion for a prayer to the Son. Calenberg-Göttingen 1542 has the same two-part thanksgiving in its common Mass, "which shall be made in all Masses after the communion" (Sehling 6/2, p. 816; see Chapter 7, §7.13.3). Oldenburg 1573 gives the Nürnberg prayer as an alternative (Sehling 7/2.1, p. 1145).

(c) The Corpus Christi collect. The most widespread alternative is a German version of the collect of Corpus Christi, "O God, who under a wonderful sacrament hast left us a memorial of thy passion: grant us, we beseech thee, so to venerate the sacred mysteries of thy body and blood, that we may ever perceive within us the fruit of thy redemption". Sehling's editors trace it to the Wittenberg hymnbook of 1533 (Sehling 6/2, p. 1076, n. 81). The identification with the Missal collect is this chapter's. **Saxony, *Ordnung* of Duke August, 1580** (Sehling 1, p. 369):

After the communion let one of the following collects be read, and let him conclude with the blessing. Collects. Let us give thanks unto the Lord and pray. We give thanks unto thee, Almighty Lord God, that thou hast refreshed us through these salutary gifts; and we beseech thy mercy, that thou wouldest make the same to prosper in us unto strong faith toward thee and unto fervent love among us all; through Jesus Christ thy Son our Lord. Answer: Amen. Or this. O thou dear Lord God, who in this wonderful sacrament hast commanded us to remember and to preach thy passion; grant us so to use this sacrament of thy body and blood, that we may daily perceive in us fruitfully thy redemption. Answer: Amen.

The Latin "hast left us a memorial of thy passion" becomes "hast commanded us to remember and to preach thy passion" (1 Cor 11:26). "To venerate the sacred mysteries" becomes "so to use this sacrament". The petition *ut redemptionis tuae fructum in nobis iugiter sentiamus* (that we may ever perceive within us the fruit of thy redemption) is kept almost word for word: "that we may daily perceive thy redemption fruitfully in us". The same pair (Luther's, "or this" the Corpus Christi collect) stands in:

- Mecklenburg 1545 (below);
- Buxtehude 1565, where the Corpus Christi collect comes **first** (Sehling 7/1, p. 125);

- Mansfeld 1580 (Sehling 2, p. 227);
- Grubenhagen 1581 (Sehling 6/2, p. 1076);
- Oldenburg 1573 (Sehling 7/2.1, p. 1145);
- Nördlingen 1579 (Sehling 12, p. 382).

Grubenhagen 1581 also uses it in its old place, as the collect for Maundy Thursday ("Die coenae Domini", Sehling 6/2, p. 1078). The Württemberg order of 1536 has it among its collects as the *Oratio de Eucharistia* (Prayer of the Eucharist; Sehling 16, p. 125).

(d) Döber's prayer of 1525. Döber's Nürnberg Mass of 1525 has a postcommunion that Sehling's editor thought "apparently newly made" (Sehling 11, p. 55, n. 22). **Nürnberg, *Deutsche Messe des A. Döber*, 1525** (Sehling 11, pp. 54–55):

Thereafter he saith the collect to the people: Let us pray. O Lord Almighty God, grant us in our minds and hearts that, through the temporal death of thy Son, which this worthy mystery signifieth, we may trust that thou hast given us everlasting life; through Christ our Lord. Amen.

Its pairing of "temporal" with "signifieth" and "everlasting" recalls the Corpus Christi postcommunion "Grant us, we beseech thee, O Lord, to be filled with the everlasting enjoyment of thy Godhead, which the temporal receiving of thy precious Body and Blood doth prefigure". It may be a free reworking of it; this is a suggestion, not Sehling's identification. Mecklenburg took Döber's prayer into its list of three.

Mecklenburg's three. Mecklenburg 1545 offers all three kinds: Luther's, Döber's, and the Corpus Christi collect. **Mecklenburg, *Ordeninge der misse*, 1545** (Sehling 5, p. 155):

Thereupon the priest: Let us pray. We give thanks unto thee, Almighty Lord God, that thou hast refreshed us through this salutary gift of thy body and blood; and we beseech thy mercy, that thou wouldest make the same to prosper in us unto strong faith toward thee and unto fervent love among us all; through our Lord Jesus Christ. Amen. Or at times this prayer: O Lord, almighty Father, grant us in our minds and hearts that, through the temporal death of thy Son, which this worthy mystery signifieth, we may trust that thou hast given us everlasting life; through Jesus Christ our Lord. Amen. Or this: O thou dear Lord God, who by this wonderful sacrament hast commanded us to remember and to preach thy passion; grant us so to use this sacrament of thy body and blood, that we may daily perceive in us fruitfully thy redemption; through Jesus Christ. Amen.

(e) Alternating Sundays: Prussia 1544. The Prussian order of 1544 has two postcommunions sung "to alternate every other Sunday". The second is a new prayer on the fruit of the passion. **Prussia, *Kirchenordnung*, 1544** (Sehling 4, p. 66):

Thereafter the priest turneth to the people and singeth: The Lord be with you; and turneth again to the altar, [and] singeth one of the collects with the customary accent, etc., to alternate every other Sunday. First collect: We give thanks unto thee, etc. […] Another collect: O true God, merciful Father, we heartily beseech thee, let us needy ones rightly lay hold with believing heart on the profit and fruit of the holy passion of our Lord, that is, grace and the forgiveness of our sins, even as through the word of thy holy Son we have truly received under the bread and wine his holy body and his precious blood, which he gave and shed for us; through the same our Lord Jesus Christ, thy Son, who liveth and reigneth with thee from everlasting to everlasting. Amen.

The Prussian articles of 1525 had already provided "two common collects or complendas for the end of the Mass, to alternate through the whole year". Sehling does not print them (Sehling 4, p. 37).

(f) Later replacements. Late orders sometimes replace Luther's short prayer with a longer one. At Engerhafe in East Frisia (1583) "a trinitarian thanksgiving has taken the place of Luther's short thanksgiving collect (postcommunion)", as Sehling's editor notes in comparing it with the order of 1535 (Sehling 7/1, p. 681, n. 34). The thanksgiving with the *Placeat* in Kantz's Mass of 1522 is treated in Chapter 7, §7.2.7.

5.6.5 When there was no communion

A collect instead. Without communicants the Lutheran Mass ended after the sermon, and the postcommunion slot was filled with "a collect" of the pastor's choice, not with the thanksgiving for the sacrament:

- **Saxony 1580**: "But where no communicants are present, it shall be concluded after the sermon, or a chapter of Holy Scripture read, with a Christian collect and the customary blessing" (Sehling 1, p. 369).
- **Soest 1609**: "When there are no communicants, the preacher may conclude with a collect of his own choice" (*arbitraria collecta*, Sehling 22, p. 495).

- **Lippe 1571**: a collect "or thanksgiving for the word of God heard". **Lippe, *Kirchenordnung*, 1571** (Sehling 21, p. 397):

Thereupon sing a collect or thanksgiving for the word of God which hath been heard, and conclude with a Christian hymn.

The thanksgiving for the gift of the sacrament became, in the service without communion, a thanksgiving for the gift of the Word.

The service when nobody communicated is treated in Chapter 2, §2.14, and the Litany sung in place of the Mass in Chapter 13, §13.21.1.

5.6.6 The prayer over the people (*oratio super populum*)

The medieval use. On the weekdays of Lent the Missal added a fourth proper prayer after the postcommunion. The deacon bade the people *Humiliate capita vestra Deo*, "Bow down your heads before God", and the priest said the *oratio super populum*, a prayer over the people, before the dismissal. In the Breviary the same prayers served as collects of the office on the Lenten weekdays.

Not at the Mass. No Lutheran order in the corpus keeps the *super populum* (over the people) at the end of the Mass. The bidding *Humiliate capita vestra Deo* does not occur, in Latin or in German. The corpus was searched for *super populum*, *super plebem* (over the people), *humiliate capita* (bow your heads), *inclinate capita* (incline your heads) and German phrases such as "neiget eure Häupter" (bow your heads). The Lutheran Mass had no weekday Lenten Masses to carry the prayer. Its place at the end of the Sunday Mass was held by the postcommunion collect and the Aaronic blessing. The orders describe that blessing in the same words: "the blessing over the people out of the book of Numbers" (Gnandstein 1539, Sehling 1, p. 564). Müntzer (Radical Reformation) describes his postcommunion the same way: "after the communion one giveth thanks to God over the people, and blesseth the Lord" (Sehling 1, p. 506). Neither is a *super populum* prayer.

In the office: Ansbach 1533. The one place where the *super populum* survives by name is in the Divine Office of the collegiate churches. The Brandenburg-Ansbach order of 1533 for the singing and reading in the *Stifte* goes through the Breviary and strikes out what is unfit. In Lent it strikes out the collects at Lauds (*super Benedictus*) that "speak of the fast" as a work, day by day. For their place it allows the *super populum* prayers. **Brandenburg-Ansbach-Kulmbach, *Ordnung singens und lesens bei den Stiften*, 1533** (Sehling 11, p. 315):

On Ash Wednesday the collect at the Benedictus, *Concede nobis, Domine, praesidia* (Grant us, O Lord, the protection), and other collects more which speak of the fast, as *Inchoata ieiunia* (The fasts begun) and *Adesto, Domine, supplicationibus nostris* (Be present, O Lord, at our supplications), etc., and the hymn *Ex more docti* (Taught by custom), shall not be kept. Further they shall leave out: on the Sunday Invocavit, the collect at the Benedictus *Deus, qui ecclesiam tuam* (O God, who [dost cleanse] thy church); […] on the Monday after Reminiscere, the collect at the Benedictus *Praesta, quaesumus, omnipotens Deus, familia tua* (Grant, we beseech thee, almighty God, [that] thy household), etc.; on the Wednesday, the collect at the Benedictus *Populum tuum, Domine* (Thy people, O Lord), etc.; on the Thursday, the collect at the Benedictus *Praesta nobis, Domine, quaesumus* (Grant us, O Lord, we beseech thee); on the Friday, at the Benedictus the collect *Da, quaesumus, omnipotens Deus* (Grant, we beseech thee, almighty God), etc.; on the Saturday, at the Benedictus the collect *Da, quaesumus, Domine, nostris effectum* (Grant, we beseech thee, O Lord, to our [fasts] a saving effect); and in this place they may always take the *super populum* that followeth.

What the rule means. The list goes on through the weeks of Oculi, Laetare and Judica (Sehling 11, pp. 315–316).

- **What it strikes out.** The Lauds collects of the Lenten weekdays are the collects of the day's Mass. Many of them ask that bodily fasting be made fruitful or meritorious. An example is the Monday after Reminiscere: "Grant, we beseech thee, almighty God, that thy household, which by afflicting itself abstaineth from food in the flesh, may by following righteousness fast from sin". Another is the Wednesday: "Look mercifully, O Lord, upon thy people, and grant that those whom thou biddest abstain from carnal foods may also cease from hurtful vices".
- **What it puts in their place.** "The *super populum* that followeth" is the prayer over the people of the same day, which stands after the postcommunion in the Missal. These prayers ask for God's protection, mercy and guidance of his people, without reference to the fast. For the same Monday it is "Be present, almighty God, at our supplications, and to those to whom thou grantest confidence of hoping for thy goodness, graciously give the effect of thy wonted mercy".

The identification of these texts is this chapter's. Sehling's editor gives no note on the passage.

The result. The Lenten prayer over the people outlived the Lenten collect in this one Lutheran order. It did so not at the end of the Mass but at Lauds, and for a doctrinal reason: of the day's two proper prayers it was the one that said nothing of fasting as a work. Ansbach's handling matches Luther's test for the collect in 1523, "if only it be godly" (§5.3.2). The corpus shows no other Lutheran use of the *super populum*.

5.7 Kept, stripped, added, altered

Table 1. The prayers, compared with the medieval system

	Collect	Secret	Postcommunion	Prayer over the people (Lent)
Medieval use	Proper to the day; sung after the Gloria; multiplied by commemorations and votive collects	Proper to the day; said silently over the gifts; multiplied with the collects	Proper to the day; sung after the communion; multiplied with the collects	Proper to the Lenten weekdays; after the postcommunion, with the bidding *Humiliate capita vestra Deo*; also used as an office collect
Kept	The collect of the season or feast (§5.4.2), mostly German versions of the Missal collects; the salutation, *Oremus*, long conclusion and Amen (§5.4.5); the seasonal versicle (Henneberg 1582, Hof 1592)	Only the closing *Per omnia saecula saeculorum. Amen* (World without end. Amen; Müntzer (Radical Reformation), Lippe, Calenberg-Göttingen), and the name in Dortmund 1554 (§5.5.2)	A collect after the communion, with salutation and Amen; often still called the *complenda* (completion; §5.6.3). Proper postcommunions kept in Nürnberg and Volprecht 1524, Coburg 1524, Müntzer 1524 (Radical Reformation), Erfurt 1525 and Calenberg-Göttingen 1542 (§5.6.2)	Only in the office: Ansbach 1533 allows the day's *super populum* (over the people) at Lauds (§5.6.6)
Stripped	Collects of the saints and those asking their intercession (Hannover 1536); the automatic commemorations (Luther: "that one alone")	The prayer itself, everywhere (Prussia 1525: "of necessity left out"); no German secret exists	The proper postcommunion (Luther 1523: "they almost all sound of sacrifice"); gone from the printed orders after 1542	At the Mass, everywhere; neither the prayer nor the bidding occurs
Added	Veit Dietrich's gospel collects (Wolfenbüttel 1569, Soest 1609, Buxtehude 1565); new "common" collects for need; the collect for peace after *Verleih uns Frieden* (Grant us peace)	Open prayers for the magistrates and Christendom in its place (Dortmund 1554); collects for rulers under the Sanctus (Döber 1525, Brandenburg 1540, Calenberg-Göttingen 1542, Pfalz-Neuburg 1543)	Luther's fixed thanksgiving (1526); the Nürnberg thanksgiving (1533); Döber's prayer (1525); Prussia's second collect (1544); a collect or thanksgiving for the Word when there is no communion (Lippe 1571)	—
Altered	Latin to German "that the people may say Amen" (Coburg 1554/55); one collect as the norm, a second only "for need"	—	Proper to ordinary; Luther's 1523 ablution prayers made public, then expanded (Nürnberg 1533); the Missal postcommunion *Gratias tibi*	Moved from the end of the Mass to Lauds, in place of collects that "speak of the fast" (Ansbach 1533)

	Collect	Secret	Postcommunion	Prayer over the people (Lent)
	(Mecklenburg 1545) or by rule for temporal goods (Ansbach 1548); the Advent *Excita* reworded ("awaken us, that we may be ready")		*referimus* (We give thee thanks) recast as Luther's thanksgiving; the Corpus Christi collect turned into a postcommunion; two thanksgivings joined "under one conclusion" (Brandenburg 1540, Pfalz-Neuburg 1543)	

Table 2. Did the medieval "two collects, two secrets, two postcommunions" survive?

Feature	Survives?	Where
More than one collect before the epistle	**Yes, in some orders**	Ansbach 1548 (two, by rule); Mecklenburg 1545 (a second "for need"); Wolfstein 1574 and Henneberg ("one or more")
A matching second secret	**No**	The secret is gone altogether
A matching second postcommunion	**No, but two postcommunions do occur**, not tied to the collects	Brandenburg 1540 and Pfalz-Neuburg 1543 (Nürnberg and Luther thanksgivings "under one conclusion"); Calenberg-Göttingen 1542 (Luther's thanksgiving plus the proper postcommunion of the feast)
A votive prayer at the end	**Yes**	The collect for peace after *Verleih uns Frieden* (twelve or more orders); Hof 1592's collect "for rain and fair weather"
Rules for the conclusions	**Yes**	Hof 1592 (§5.4.5)
The Lenten prayer over the people	**Not at the Mass**; once in the office	Ansbach 1533, at Lauds (§5.6.6)

5.8 Table by order

Key.

- **L**: Latin. **G**: German or Low German.
- **Proper**: varies with the day. **Fixed**: the same every time.
- **—**: absent or abolished. **?**: not stated.
- "Luther": Luther's thanksgiving of 1526. "Nürnberg": the Brandenburg-Nürnberg thanksgiving of 1533. "Corpus Christi": the German Corpus Christi collect.

Order	Vol.	Collect	Second collect	Secret	Postcommunion	Alternatives
Luther, *Formula missae*, 1523	1	L, proper, "one alone"	—	—	L, fixed: *Quod ore* (What with our mouth), *Corpus tuum* (Thy body)	either of the two
Volprecht, Nürnberg, 1524	11	L "one only"; G proper (Trinity)	—	—	L proper (*de quo sit missa*, of whatever Mass is said); G *Proficiat* (May [the	—

Order	Vol.	Collect	Second collect	Secret	Postcommunion	Alternatives
					receiving] profit; Trinity)	
Nürnberg parish Mass, 1524	11	L proper (*Sancti tui nominis*)	—	— (with the offertory)	L proper (*complenda*)	—
Coburg proposal, 1524	1	?	?	— (with the offertory)	"the complenda"	—
Müntzer, Allstedt, 1524 (Radical Reformation)	1	G proper (Missal)	—	*Per omnia* (World without end) only	G proper (Missal postcommunions)	—
Strasbourg, Schwarz, 1524 (Moderate Reformed)	20/1	G	?	—	G *Quod ore* as *Complenda*	"any other that seemeth Christian"
Döber, Nürnberg, 1525	11	?	Optional "common prayer" before the Sanctus	—	G, new (Döber's)	—
Erfurt, *Deutsches Kirchenamt*, 1525	2	G proper	—	?	G proper (Pentecost, *Proficiat*)	—
Prussia, *Artikel*, 1525	4	Proper series by the year	?	— ("of necessity left out")	Two common complendas, alternating	—
Luther, *Deutsche Messe*, 1526	1	G, one, facing the altar	—	—	G fixed (Luther)	—
Ansbach, *Ordnung … bei den Stiften*, 1533	11	(office) Lenten Lauds collects "of the fast" struck out	—	—	—	the day's *super populum* (over the people) at Lauds in their place
Brandenburg-Nürnberg, 1533	11	?	?	?	G fixed (Nürnberg)	—
Hatzkerode, 1534(?)	2	?	?	?	Luther, called "the complenda"	"or the like"
Bremen, 1534	7/2.2	L from the Missal or G from the hymnbook	?	?	?	—
Hannover, 1536	6/2	Purged (saints' collects removed)	?	?	?	—
Württemberg, 1536	16	Collect series	?	?	?	Corpus Christi as *Oratio de Eucharistia*

Order	Vol.	Collect	Second collect	Secret	Postcommunion	Alternatives
						(Prayer of the Eucharist)
Saxony (Duke Henry), 1539	1	L or G, "common or of the feasts"	Peace collect	?	?	—
Brandenburg, 1540	3	?	Four G collects under the Sanctus	—	G: Nürnberg + Luther under one conclusion; then L *Corpus tuum*, *Quod ore*	—
Calenberg-Göttingen, 1542	6/2	G proper (Müntzer (Radical Reformation), Missal)	Collect for rulers under the Sanctus; peace collect at the end	*Per omnia* as "God be praised …"	G: Luther (Nürnberg + Luther in the common Mass) then G proper (Missal)	*Qui dixisti* (Who saidst) in the common Mass
Schleswig-Holstein, 1542	23	?	?	?	"a collect of thanksgiving"	—
Pfalz-Neuburg, 1543	13	?	Three collects under the Sanctus	Osiander's prayer over the gifts (new)	G: Nürnberg + Luther (to Christ) under one conclusion; then L *Corpus tuum*, *Quod ore*	—
Prussia, *Kirchenordnung*, 1544	4	?	?	?	Luther	second collect on alternate Sundays
Mecklenburg, 1545	5	G "one at a time"	A second "for great need"	?	Luther	Döber's; Corpus Christi
Ansbach, *Auctuarium*, 1548	11	Two by rule: spiritual, then temporal	(the second)	?	?	—
Amberg, 1550	13	L of the season "if it be pure"	?	?	Postcommunion "probably that of Pfalz-Neuburg" (editor)	—
Breslau, 1550	3	?	?	?	"the complenda"	—
Reuss, 1552	2	?	?	?	"the complenda after our church's use", toward the people	—
Dortmund, 1554	21	?	?	Open prayer for rulers "in place of the Secret"	?	—
Coburg, 1554/55	1	G only, "that the people may sing Amen"	?	?	?	—

Order	Vol.	Collect	Second collect	Secret	Postcommunion	Alternatives
Senftenberg, 1555	1	?	?	?	"the complenda", in Wendish for the Wends	—
Lüneburg, 1564	6/1	G of the season or feast "or that agreeth with the matter"	?	?	Luther	?
Buxtehude, *Agende*, 1565	7/1	Two: Missal (before the sermon), Dietrich (after)	?	?	Corpus Christi first	Luther
Wolfenbüttel, 1569	6/1	G series; may be Dietrich's gospel collects	?	?	Luther	?
Lippe, 1571	21	?	?	?	Luther	without communion: a collect or thanksgiving for the Word
Oldenburg, 1573	7/2.1	Very large G series (Wolfenbüttel's and more)	Peace collect	?	Luther	Corpus Christi; Nürnberg
Wolfstein, 1574	13	G, "one or more"	(as needed)	?	?	—
Nördlingen, 1579	12	?	?	?	Luther, after a versicle from 1 Cor 11:26	Corpus Christi, after 1 Cor 11:27
Saxony (Duke August), 1580; Mansfeld, 1580	1; 2	G series	Peace collect (Mansfeld)	?	Luther	Corpus Christi
Grubenhagen, 1581	6/2	G series (Missal)	Peace collect	?	Luther	Corpus Christi (also on Maundy Thursday)
Henneberg, 1582	2	G "pure collects" by season, with versicles	Common collects "for every need"	?	?	—
Engerhafe, 1583	7/1	?	?	?	Trinitarian thanksgiving in place of Luther's	—
Hof, 1592	11	Of the season or "directed to the Lord's Supper"; L at Vespers	"For rain and fair weather" (Vespers)	?	A collect, e.g. the thanksgiving for the Supper received	—

Order	Vol.	Collect	Second collect	Secret	Postcommunion	Alternatives
Verden, 1606	7/1	G series	?	?	Luther	?
Soest, 1609	22	"That agreeth with the gospel", or one for the Spirit	?	?	?	without communion: a collect of free choice
Schaumburg, 1614	7/2.2	G series	Peace collect	?	?	?
Osnabrück, (1588) 1618	7/1	G series (Missal, Coelius)	?	?	Luther	?

5.9 Concordance of the orders quoted

Every order quoted or cited in this chapter is listed below by region. The table gives:

- **Sehling**: the volume and pages in Sehling's edition.
- **Doc**: the `eko.db` document that holds the text, for full-text lookup. A single database record may hold several orders.
- **§**: the sections where the order is quoted or cited ("A" = Appendix 5.A).

Saxony, Thuringia and central Germany

Order	Sehling	Doc	§
Luther, *Formula missae et communionis*, 1523	1, pp. 3–6	2	5.3.2, 5.4.1, 5.4.3, 5.6.1, 5.A
Allstedt, Thomas Müntzer, *Deutsch evangelisch messe*, 1524 (Radical Reformation)	1, pp. 500–504	51, 52	5.5.2, 5.6.2, 5.A
Coburg, *Gottesdienst-Ordnung* (proposal), 1524	1, p. 542	72	5.6.2
Allstedt, Thomas Müntzer, *Ordnung und berechnunge des teutschen ampts*, 1523/24 (Radical Reformation)	1, p. 506	52	5.6.6
Erfurt, *Deutsches Kirchenamt*, 1525	2, pp. 376–378	1251	5.6.2, 5.A
Luther, *Deutsche Messe und ordnung gottis diensts*, 1526	1, pp. 14, 16	3	5.3.3, 5.4.5, 5.A
Hatzkerode, *Kirchenordnunge*, 1534(?)	2, p. 587	1263	5.6.3
Gnandstein, visitation articles, 1539	1, p. 564	85	5.6.6
Albertine Saxony, *Kirchenordnunge zum anfang* (Duke Henry), 1539	1, pp. 274–278	30	5.4.1, 5.4.2, 5.4.5
Reuss, *Kirchen-Ordnung* of Heinrich IV, 1552	2, p. 154	1234	5.6.3
Coburg, *Vorschaffung* of the visitation of 1554/55	1, p. 544	74	5.4.5
Senftenberg, *Kirchen-Ordnung*, 1555	1, p. 672	136	5.6.3
Albertine Saxony, *Ordnung* of Duke August, 1580	1, pp. 369, 375	44	5.4.2, 5.6.3, 5.6.4, 5.6.5
Mansfeld, *Kirchen-agenda*, 1580	2, pp. 227–231	1241	5.4.2, 5.6.4

Order	Sehling	Doc	§
Henneberg, *Kirchen ordnung* of Georg Ernst, 1582	2, pp. 317, 320	1247	5.4.1, 5.4.2, 5.4.3
Henneberg, a pastor's report	2, p. 330	1248	5.4.1

Franconia, the Upper Palatinate and Swabia

Order	Sehling	Doc	§
Nürnberg, *Deutsche Messe des Priors Volprecht*, 1524	11, pp. 39, 42	247	5.4.1, 5.5.1, 5.6.2, 5.A
Nürnberg, *Gottesdienstordnung der Pfarrkirchen*, 1524	11, pp. 46–49	249	5.3.1, 5.4.1, 5.5.1, 5.6.2
Nürnberg, *Deutsche Messe des A. Döber*, 1525	11, pp. 54–55	250	5.5.2, 5.6.4, 5.A
Brandenburg-Ansbach-Kulmbach, *Ordnung singens und lesens bei den Stiften*, 1533	11, pp. 315–316	276	5.6.6
Brandenburg-Nürnberg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1533	11, p. 197	270	5.6.4, 5.A
Württemberg, *Gemein kirchenordnung*, 1536	16, p. 125	651	5.6.4
Pfalz-Neuburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1543	13, p. 76	386	5.5.2, 5.6.1, 5.6.4
Brandenburg-Ansbach-Kulmbach, *Auctuarium*, 1548 (Interim order)	11, p. 330	278	5.4.1
Amberg (Kuroberpfalz), *Kirchenordnung*, 1550	13, p. 286	411	5.4.3, 5.4.5
Wolfstein, *Christliche Instructio* of Thomas Stieber, 1574	13, p. 576	463	5.4.1, 5.4.5
Nördlingen, *Kirchenordnung*, 1579	12, p. 382	375	5.6.3, 5.6.4
Hof, *Ordo ecclesiasticus*, 1592	11, pp. 411–429	294	5.4.1, 5.4.2, 5.4.5

Brandenburg, Prussia, Silesia, Mecklenburg

Order	Sehling	Doc	§
Prussia, *Artikel der ceremonien und anderer kirchenordnung*, 1525	4, pp. 32, 37	1832, 1833	5.5.1, 5.6.4
Brandenburg, *Kirchen-ordnung* of Joachim II, 1540	3, p. 70	1746	5.5.2, 5.6.1, 5.6.4
Prussia, *Kirchenordnung*, 1544	4, p. 66	1833	5.6.4
Mecklenburg, *Ordeninge der misse*, 1545	5, pp. 152, 155	1922	5.4.1, 5.4.5, 5.6.3, 5.6.4
Breslau, 1550	3, p. 404	1807	5.6.3

Lower Saxony, Westphalia and the North

Order	Sehling	Doc	§
Bremen, *Kirchenordnung*, 1534	7/2.2, p. 459	2217	5.4.5
Hannover, *Kirchenordnung*, 1536	6/2, p. 1009	2051	5.4.3
Calenberg-Göttingen, *Kirchenordnung*, 1542	6/2, pp. 816–834	2036, 2037	5.4.1, 5.5.2, 5.6.2, 5.6.4, 5.A
Lippe, Corvinus's *Zeremonienordnung*, [1542]	21, p. 352	1460	5.4.4

Order	Sehling	Doc	§
Schleswig-Holstein, *Christlyke Kercken Ordeninge*, 1542	23, p. 91	1576	5.6.3
Dortmund, *Gottesdienstordnung*, 1554	21, p. 209	1446	5.5.2
Lüneburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1564	6/1, pp. 542–543, 568–573	2003, 2005	5.3.3, 5.4.2, 5.4.4
Buxtehude, *Agende*, 1565 (and Sehling's introduction)	7/1, pp. 67, 92–98, 125	2080, 2082	5.4.2, 5.4.4, 5.6.4
Wolfenbüttel, *Kirchenordnung*, 1569	6/1, pp. 178–179	1974	5.4.2, 5.4.4
Lippe, *Kirchenordnung*, 1571	21, p. 397	1462	5.6.5
Oldenburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1573 (and Sehling's introduction)	7/2.1, pp. 962, 1134–1145	2142, 2151	5.4.2, 5.4.4, 5.6.4
Grubenhagen, *Kirchenordnung*, 1581	6/2, pp. 1076–1081	2058	5.4.2, 5.6.4
Engerhafe, *Liturgie*, 1583	7/1, p. 681	2119	5.6.4
Ysenburg-Birstein, *Kirchenordnung*, 1588	10, p. 622	228	5.4.2
Verden, *Kirchenordnung*, 1606	7/1, p. 161	2090	5.3.3, 5.4.2, 5.6.3, 5.A
Soest, *Kirchenordnung*, 1609	22, pp. 488, 495	1538	5.4.4, 5.6.5
Schaumburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1614	7/2.2, p. 150	2178	5.4.1, 5.4.2
Osnabrück, *Agende*, (1588) 1618	7/1, pp. 270–278	2100	5.4.2, 5.6.3

Strasbourg

Order	Sehling	Doc	§
Strasbourg, the early agendas: Schwarz's German Mass and the *Teutsche Meß*, 1524 (Moderate Reformed)	20/1, pp. 123, 133, 135	1279	5.3.1, 5.6.1, 5.A

Appendix 5.A The postcommunion texts and their sources

The prayers used after the communion in the corpus, with their Latin sources where one exists. "Ed." means that Sehling's editors make the identification; "this chapter" means that the identification is this chapter's own. The texts and translations are given in the sections named.

German incipit	Latin source	Identified by	Orders	§
(Latin) *Quod ore sumpsimus, Domine, pura mente capiamus* (What we have taken with our mouth, O Lord, may we receive with a pure mind)	Priest's prayer at the ablutions, Ordo Missae	Luther 1523	Luther 1523; Brandenburg 1540; Pfalz-Neuburg 1543	5.3.2, 5.6.1
(Latin) *Corpus tuum, Domine, quod sumpsimus* … (Thy body, O Lord, which we have received …)	Priest's prayer at the ablutions, Ordo Missae	Luther 1523	Luther 1523; Brandenburg 1540; Pfalz-Neuburg 1543	5.3.2, 5.6.1

German incipit	Latin source	Identified by	Orders	§
"What we have taken with our mouth, grant us, Lord …"	*Quod ore sumpsimus* (What we have taken with our mouth)	Evident from the text	Strasbourg 1524 (*Complenda*; Moderate Reformed); Volprecht 1524	5.6.1
"The receiving of thy sacrament, O Lord our God …" / "O Lord God, let … the receiving of the holy sacrament come to our profit"	*Proficiat nobis ad salutem corporis et animae* (May [the receiving] profit us for the health of body and soul; Trinity Sunday, postcommunion)	Chapter 7 (Volprecht); this chapter (Erfurt)	Volprecht 1524 (Trinity); Erfurt 1525 (Trinity)	5.6.2
"O Lord, pour into us the spirit of love …" / "Lord, pour over us thy Spirit …"	*Spiritum nobis, Domine, tuae caritatis infunde* (Pour into us, O Lord, the Spirit of thy love; Easter, postcommunion)	Ed. (Calenberg-Göttingen); this chapter (Müntzer)	Müntzer 1524 (Radical Reformation); Calenberg-Göttingen 1542	5.6.2
"O Lord, grant us the grace of the Holy Ghost, that the dew of thy goodness …"	*Sancti Spiritus, Domine, corda nostra mundet infusio* (May the infusion of the Holy Spirit cleanse our hearts, O Lord; Pentecost, postcommunion)	Ed. (Calenberg-Göttingen); Chapter 7	Müntzer 1524 (Radical Reformation); Erfurt 1525; Calenberg-Göttingen 1542	5.6.2
"Lord, let us receive thy mercy in the midst of thy temple …"	*Suscipiamus, Domine, misericordiam tuam in medio templi tui* (We have received thy mercy, O Lord, in the midst of thy temple; 1st Sunday in Advent, postcommunion)	Ed.	Calenberg-Göttingen 1542	5.6.2
"O Lord God, stand hard by us …"	none known (new)	Chapter 7	Müntzer 1524 (Advent; Radical Reformation)	5.6.2
"We give thanks to thee, almighty Lord God, that thou hast refreshed us through this salutary gift …"	*Gratias tibi referimus, Domine, sacro munere vegetati* (We give thee thanks, O Lord, being quickened by the sacred gift; 18th Sunday after Pentecost, postcommunion)	Ed. (Verden, after Drews)	Luther 1526, and nearly every later order	5.3.3, 5.6.3
"O almighty, eternal God, we give praise and thanks to thy divine bounty …"	none (new); expands *Quod ore sumpsimus*	This chapter	Brandenburg-Nürnberg 1533; Brandenburg 1540; Calenberg-Göttingen 1542; Pfalz-Neuburg 1543; Oldenburg 1573	5.6.4
"O Lord, almighty God, grant us … that through the temporal death of thy Son …"	"apparently newly made" (ed.); perhaps from *Fac nos … quam pretiosi Corporis et Sanguinis tui temporalis perceptio praefigurat* (Grant us … which the temporal receiving of thy precious Body and Blood doth prefigure; Corpus Christi, postcommunion)	Ed.; suggestion of this chapter	Döber 1525; Mecklenburg 1545	5.6.4

German incipit	Latin source	Identified by	Orders	§
"Ah thou dear Lord God, who in this wonderful sacrament hast commanded us to remember and preach thy passion …"	*Deus, qui nobis sub sacramento mirabili passionis tuae memoriam reliquisti* (O God, who under a wonderful sacrament hast left us a memorial of thy passion; Corpus Christi, collect)	This chapter; ed. trace it to the Wittenberg hymnbook of 1533	Württemberg 1536; Mecklenburg 1545; Buxtehude 1565; Oldenburg 1573; Nördlingen 1579; Saxony 1580; Mansfeld 1580; Grubenhagen 1581	5.6.4
"O true God, merciful Father … let us, needy ones, lay hold of the profit and fruit of the holy passion of our Lord …"	none known	—	Prussia 1544 (alternate Sundays)	5.6.4
"O Lord Jesus Christ, who saidst unto thine apostles: My peace I give unto you …"	*Domine Iesu Christe, qui dixisti apostolis tuis* (O Lord Jesus Christ, who saidst unto thine apostles; Ordo Missae, prayer for peace)	Ed.	Calenberg-Göttingen 1542 (common Mass)	5.6.2
"Lord God, heavenly Father, who workest holy desires, good counsel and right works …" (after *Verleih uns Frieden* [Grant us peace])	*Deus, a quo sancta desideria, recta consilia, et iusta sunt opera* (O God, from whom all holy desires, all good counsels and all just works do proceed; Mass for peace)	Ed.	Saxony 1539; Calenberg-Göttingen 1542; Henneberg 1582; Grubenhagen 1581; Oldenburg 1573; Schaumburg 1614; and others	5.4.1, 5.6.2

Chapter 6. The General Prayer of the Church: Texts by Family

The general prayer (*das gemein Gebet*, the Prayer of the Church) is the intercession for all estates and needs in the chief Sunday service of the church orders in the Sehling corpus. This chapter does two things:

- §§6.1–6.3 say what the general prayer is, where it stands in the service, and how its texts are related.
- §§6.4–6.21 give the texts themselves, one family at a time. For each petition the original is followed by the English, for the rubric, the bid and the prayer in turn. Each family can be read straight through, in the order in which the prayer runs.

The texts are the **representative texts** of the general-prayer workbook, `general_prayers.xlsx` (Introduction). They come from four sheets of the workbook:

- **Orig Prayers - Representative**;
- **Eng Prayers - Representative**;
- **Orig Bids - Representative**;
- **Eng Bids - Representative**.

The workbook sets these out with one row per category and one column per family, so that one intention can be compared across the families. Here they are turned around: each family's column is printed as a single prayer.

The Introduction (The general-prayer workbook and database) describes the workbook and `general_prayers.db`: how the texts were curated and checked against the corpus, the categories, and how the critical and representative texts are made. The workbook also gives:

- every witness's own text, in the **Prayers** sheet;
- the variants within a family, in the **Archetypes** sheet and the critical sheets;
- the orders side by side, petition by petition, in the **Compare** sheet.

Related chapters. Several subjects are treated more fully elsewhere:

- the place of the general prayer in the order of the Mass: Chapter 2, §§2.4–2.5;
- the prayer before the sermon, the greeting and the notices: Chapter 11, §11.10;
- the Litany and the bidding prayers: Chapter 13, §13.21;
- the intercessions under the Sanctus in the Masses that have them: Chapter 7, §§7.8.11, 7.12.2, 7.14.4;
- the collects: Chapter 5, §5.4.

The labels of the texts (rubric, bid, prayer and witnesses) are explained in the Conventions.

6.1 The general prayer in the Sunday service

6.1.1 What it is

Every order in this set (57 witnesses, dated 1526–1618) has one prayer in the chief service of the Sunday in which the congregation prays for the Church and her ministers, the magistrates, the afflicted and the other needs of Christendom. The orders call it:

- *das gemein gebet*, the common prayer. This is the usual name: Württemberg 1553 has "Ordnung des gemeinen gebets" (Order of the common prayer), Leipzig 1567 "Gemein gebet" (Common prayer).
- *Vermanung zum gebet*, the exhortation to prayer: Hessen 1566 (Moderate Reformed), Strasbourg 1598. Nürnberg 1545 has "Vermanung zu bitten für allerlei stende" (Exhortation to pray for all estates).
- *Fürbitt* (intercession) or *Vorbitt*, intercession: Augsburg 1537 (Moderate Reformed; Sehling's heading), Öhringen 1544.
- *Exhortatio edder vormaninge*, exhortation or admonition: Braunschweig 1528, Hamburg 1529.
- *Oratio* (Prayer): the Latin order of the French church at Frankfurt, 1554 (Reformed).

Hessen 1566 (Moderate Reformed) gives it as the fifth part of the service and grounds it in the practice of the first Church:

> Of such prayer, which in the first Church followed upon the exposition of the Scripture and the sermon, Justin speaketh very briefly in his second Apology, where he saith: *After the exhortations made by him that presideth, we all rise and pray*

> *together*; that is, when the sermon of the chief teacher is ended, we all stand up and pray.

What counts as the general prayer, and what is left out (collect banks, the Litany, prayer-day and afternoon forms), is set out in the Introduction (What counts as the general prayer).

6.1.2 Where it stands in the service

After the sermon. In 48 of the 57 witnesses the prayer follows the sermon, and in most of them it is said from the pulpit. Kursachsen 1580 has it said "always after the sermon … to the people from the pulpit". In these orders the prayer is the hinge between the service of the Word and the Supper, and it is often joined to the items around it:

- **Before it, in many orders:** an open confession and absolution, or the publishing of banns and notices. Examples:
  - confession and absolution in Neckarbischofsheim 1560, Erbach 1560, Hohenlohe 1578, the Ysenburg orders, Braunschweig-Wolfenbüttel 1569, Oldenburg 1573 and Kurpfalz 1563 (Reformed);
  - banns and notices in Hohenlohe 1578, Solms-Laubach 1576, Strasbourg 1598 and Frankfurt 1554 (Reformed).
- **After it:** the Our Father, which closes almost every form. Then:
  - a psalm or hymn, such as "Erhalt uns Herr" (Keep us, Lord), "Verleih uns Frieden" (Grant us peace) or "Danck sagen wir alle" (Let us all give thanks);
  - a collect and the blessing when there is no Communion;
  - otherwise the Supper. In Lüneburg 1564 and its followers the communicants come into the choir and kneel.

Elsewhere in the service. The other nine witnesses place it as follows:

Place	Witnesses
In the Mass, said by the priest in German under the Sanctus, before or after the Words of Institution	Brandenburg 1540, Calenberg-Göttingen 1542, Pfalz-Neuburg 1543 (family L)
In the Communion office, after the exhortation to the communicants, before the Words of Institution	Frankfurt 1553 and 1589
After the Kyrie and Gloria, in place of the Latin collect, read from a lectern before the altar (the sermon precedes the whole service)	Schwäbisch Hall 1526
In place of the Epistle in the village Mass, followed by the Creed, the Ten Commandments and the catechism (the medieval pulpit office)	Nürnberg 1545
After the Gospel has been expounded from the pulpit and the catechism recited, before the Creed and Preface	Osnabrück 1543
From the pulpit, when the choir has finished the first psalm or hymn	Worms 1560

The Brandenburg prayers keep the place of the old intercessions of the Canon. Sehling notes on Pfalz-Neuburg 1543:

> These prayers are set in the place of the intercessory prayers spoken in the Roman Mass partly before and partly after the consecration. Elsewhere in the evangelical church orders these were struck out without replacement, because they rest upon the sacrificial character of the Mass, which the Reformation rejected.

Who says it. The minister says it: the pastor or the deacon from the pulpit, or the priest at the altar in family L. In Schwäbisch Hall 1526 it is read from a lectern before the altar, in a cope. The people take part:

- by saying the Our Father;
- by the confession, which they say after the minister in Braunschweig ("say ye also the confession with me") and in Ysenburg-Ronneburg 1582 ("Confess with me your sins before God");
- by praying "with mouth and heart", as the Leipzig print of 1567 directs.

6.1.3 Its forms

The witnesses use six forms. Each family keeps to one form, except for the two prescriptions of contents: Magdeburg 1562 (in B2) and Osnabrück 1543 (in H).

Form	How it runs	Families	Witnesses
Bidding and collect	For each intention the minister bids the people ("Let us pray for …"), then says a collect	A, B1	10
Bidding exhortation	The minister tells the people what to pray for, item by item, without addressing God, and closes with the Our Father	C, D, G, H, I, J, M	14
Continuous prayer	One prayer to God that names the intentions in turn ("Wouldest thou also …")	B2, E, F, R1, R3, R4	25
Collects	Separate collects without biddings: three from the pulpit (K), or the priest's collects under the Sanctus (L)	K, L	4
Lord's Prayer paraphrase	The intentions are arranged under the petitions of the Our Father	R2 (and the close of R3)	2
Prescription of contents	Not a text to be read, but a list in indirect speech of what the prayer must contain	Magdeburg 1562 (B2), Osnabrück 1543 (H)	2

Long and short forms. Württemberg 1553 prints a long form (B1) and a short form (B2). Pfalz-Zweibrücken 1557 says when each is to be used:

> This prayer, forasmuch as it is somewhat long, the ministers of the Church may use at the great feasts, as on Christmas Day, Easter and Pentecost, and at any other time in the year when the church is not otherwise held long by the sermon; else they shall commonly read to the people the shorter form, which followeth hereafter.

The short form became the most copied prayer in the corpus (17 witnesses, 1553–1618).

Alternatives and freedom. Some orders allow the prayer to vary:

- **The Litany instead.** The Litany is the second form of the common prayer in Württemberg 1553 and Rothenburg 1559. It is prayed on Fridays in the towns of Kursachsen 1580 and on alternate Sundays in Rothenberg 1618.
- **A choice of texts.** Kurpfalz 1563 (Reformed) offers a Lord's-Prayer paraphrase, "Or thus" (or thus), beside its Sunday prayer (R2). Augsburg 1537 (Moderate Reformed) offers two texts against the Turk.
- **Local adaptation.**
  - Hessen 1566 (Moderate Reformed) lets each church make the form "shorter or longer".
  - Hanau-Lichtenberg 1573 tells the pastor to refer to the sermon and to present needs.
  - Bentheim-Tecklenburg 1588 (Reformed) lets ministers add to the prayer in time of need.
  - Many forms end with a rubric that lets the sick and other particular needs be named (the category *Special intercessions*).

6.1.4 The sequence of intentions

Lutheran. The usual Lutheran series goes back to Brenz 1526 and Württemberg 1553:

exhortation > Church > magistrates > afflicted > peace > enemies > women with child > fruits of the earth > Our Father.

Reformed. The Heidelberg prayer of 1563 begins with confession and thanksgiving, prays for the fruit of the Word, and has a petition for all men (1 Tim 2:1):

confession > thanksgiving > Word > magistrates > fruits of the earth > all men > persecuted > afflicted > Our Father.

What all share. Civil authority is the one intention found in every witness. The Introduction (What the comparison shows) sets out the other patterns.

Traditions.

The traditions follow the inventory in Chapter 1, §1.3. Every order of another tradition than the Lutheran is marked where it is cited, by its tradition in brackets after it, as "Kurpfalz 1563 (Reformed)".

- Eleven families are Lutheran: A to E and H to L.
- F (Augsburg 1537) is Moderate Reformed: Upper German and Bucerian.
- G (Hessen 1566) is Moderate Reformed: the church of Philip of Hesse, between Wittenberg and the Upper Germans, which bore Bucer's stamp.
- M (Norden 1528) is an early East Frisian evangelical order, which Sehling prints among the Reformed orders of East Frisia; it is marked Reformed here.
- R1–R4 are Reformed. Schaumburg 1614, a Lutheran order, takes over the Heidelberg prayer of R1.
- No Interim order is among the witnesses.

6.2 How the texts are given here

Representative texts. A family's representative text is one clean text for each category, made from all the family's witnesses by majority:

- a petition, bid or prayer is kept if at least half the witnesses to that category have it;
- word by word, the reading of the majority is chosen;
- where no reading has half the witnesses, the earliest witness's reading stands.

Every word comes from a witness, but in a family with several witnesses the result need not match any one witness exactly. Where a family has a single witness, its text is that witness's text. The rules are given in full in the Introduction (Representative texts).

Order. The workbook lists the categories in a standard order. Here each family's petitions follow the order in which its prayer actually runs:

- the order of the family's earliest witness;
- with petitions that only later witnesses have placed where those witnesses have them.

Where a family has more than one petition in a category (two petitions for the magistrates in Lüneburg 1564, or the confession and the absolution), the workbook cell holds them both, separated by a blank line. Here each is given in its own place.

Exact reproduction. The petitions of each family, joined category by category, reproduce the four workbook sheets exactly. This was checked for all 2,016 cells (28 categories × 18 families × 4 sheets), with no differences. The workbook's "Bids" sheets put the rubric on the first line of the bid; here the rubric and the bid are given separately.

Each petition is numbered within its family (A.1, A.2, …) and headed with its category. For families with more than one witness, a line in italics names the witnesses that have the petition. It also notes where a rubric, bid or prayer is in only some of them. Then come, in turn:

- the rubric, original then English;
- the bid, original then English;
- the prayer, original then English.

Each part is given only where the petition has it.

Not taken in. Each family section lists the witness petitions that are not in the representative text, because another reading of the same category has the majority. Those texts are in the **Prayers** sheet and in the critical sheets.

6.3 The families at a glance

One row per family, in the order of the workbook columns. "Petitions" is the number of petitions in the representative text given below.

Family	Name	Tradition	Language	Form	Witnesses	Dates	Petitions
A	Brenz bidding prayer	Lutheran	German	bidding + collect	5	1526–1589	15

Family	Name	Tradition	Language	Form	Witnesses	Dates	Petitions
B1	Württemberg long form	Lutheran	German	preface, then bidding + collect for each intention	5	1553–1574	13
B2	Württemberg short form	Lutheran	German	exhortation + one continuous prayer	17	1553–1618	15
C	Bidding exhortation (Strasbourg type)	Lutheran	German	bidding exhortation + Our Father	1	1573	8
D	Nürnberg-type Vermahnung zum Gebet	Lutheran	German	bidding exhortation + Our Father	5	1545–1582	15
E	Saxon Gemein Gebet (Melanchthon/Pfeffinger)	Lutheran	German	continuous prayer	1	1567	6
F	Upper German pulpit intercession (Strasbourg/Zürich)	Moderate Reformed (Upper German, Bucerian)	German	continuous prayer with rubrics + Our Father	1	1537	16
G	Hessian Vermanung zum Gebet	Moderate Reformed (Hessian, Bucerian)	German	numbered bidding exhortation	1	1566	9
H	Bugenhagen pulpit exhortation	Lutheran	Low German	pulpit exhortation: Creed, confession, biddings, Our Father	3	1528–1543	9
I	Huberinus Vorbitt (Lord's-Prayer order)	Lutheran	German	bidding exhortation + Our Father	1	1544	9
J	Lower Saxon notel (Lüneburg/Wolfenbüttel)	Lutheran	German	bidding exhortation + Our Father	3	1564–1573	8
K	Three collects from the pulpit	Lutheran	German	exhortation + three collects	1	1560	5
L	Intercessions under the Sanctus (Brandenburg 1540)	Lutheran	German	collects said by the priest under the Sanctus	3	1540–1543	5
M	Pulpit biddings in the Prone pattern	Reformed (early East Frisian evangelical order)	Low Dutch	biddings, then Decalogue, confession, Creed, Our Father	1	1528	4

Family	Name	Tradition	Language	Form	Witnesses	Dates	Petitions
R1	Heidelberg 1563 prayer	Reformed (Schaumburg 1614 Lutheran)	German	confession + absolution + continuous prayer + Our Father	5	1563–1614	10
R2	Heidelberg Lord's-Prayer paraphrase	Reformed	German	Lord's Prayer paraphrase	2	1563–1588	9
R3	Calvin's "grande prière" (Strasbourg/Geneva)	Reformed	Latin	continuous prayer ending in a Lord's Prayer paraphrase	1	1554	10
R4	à Lasco/Micron (London stranger church)	Reformed	German	continuous prayer + Our Father	1	1554	10

6.4 Family A: Brenz bidding prayer

Deacon or pastor bids the people for one intention ("Let us pray for …"), then says a collect for it; the series runs Church, magistrates, peace, afflicted, all needs, and closes with the Lord's Prayer. Frankfurt adds collects from Brandenburg-Nürnberg 1533 and Veit Dietrich.

- **Earliest witness (archetype):** Schwäbisch Hall 1526 (Brenz).
- **Tradition:** Lutheran.
- **Language:** German.
- **Form:** bidding + collect.
- **Place in the service (Schwäbisch Hall 1526):** After the Kyrie and Gloria, in place of the Latin Oremus/collect; read from a lectern before the altar in a cope. The sermon precedes the whole service.

Year	Witness	Territory	Sehling	Form
1526	Schwäbisch Hall, Frühmessordnung (Johannes Brenz)	Schwäbisch Hall (Imperial city)	Sehling 17, I/1, pp. 37–40	bidding + collect
1543	Schwäbisch Hall, Kirchenordnung 1543	Schwäbisch Hall (Imperial city)	Sehling 17, I/10, pp. 142–145	bidding + collect
1553	Frankfurt am Main, Agende 1553 („Einfeltige form, das Nachtmal des Herren zuhalten")	Frankfurt am Main (Imperial city)	Sehling 9, VI/Frankfurt Nr. 10, pp. 524–526	bidding + collect
1560	Neckarbischofsheim, Kirchenordnung (Herren von Helmstatt)	Lordship of Neckarbischofsheim (Kraichgau)	Sehling 16, V, pp. 670–672	bidding + collect
1589	Frankfurt am Main, Agende 1589	Frankfurt am Main (Imperial city)	Sehling 9, VI/Frankfurt Nr. 13, pp. 552–553	bidding + collect

The representative text follows Brenz's Schwäbisch Hall form of 1526, which the later witnesses copy with small changes. Where they part from it, as in the preface and the close, its reading stands. Following the family's own majority, each bid ends "Bittend also:" (Pray ye thus:) and the collects end bare (see the Introduction, Representative texts, rule 4).

A.9 to A.13 (the Our Father, Creed and Decalogue printed as part of the prayer, and the closing rubric) stand in Schwäbisch Hall 1526 (A.9 also in 1543). A.14 is Frankfurt 1589's own closing prayer for the communicants and A.15 Neckarbischofsheim 1560's closing word of assurance. They come at the end, after the Our Father, as in those orders.

Not in the representative text (a minority reading of its category; see the Prayers sheet or the critical sheets): Frankfurt 1553 no. 1 (Exhortation / preface); Frankfurt 1553 no. 7 (Lord's Prayer); Neckarbischofsheim 1560 no. 1 (Exhortation / preface); Neckarbischofsheim 1560 no. 9 (Lord's Prayer); Frankfurt 1589 no. 1 (Exhortation / preface); Frankfurt 1589 no. 7 (Lord's Prayer).

Sequence: A.1 Exhortation / preface > A.2 The Church > A.3 Civil authority > A.4 The afflicted > A.5 Peace > A.6 Enemies > A.7 Women with child > A.8 Fruits of the earth > A.9 Lord's Prayer > A.10 Lord's Prayer > A.11 Creed > A.12 Ten Commandments > A.13 Special intercessions > A.14 Communicants > A.15 Blessing.

A.1 Exhortation / preface

Witnesses: Schwäbisch Hall 1526 and Schwäbisch Hall 1543.

Rubric. Preface

Bid. To the end that all the faithful might be stirred up to pray, our Lord Christ hath annexed unto prayer an earnest assurance, saying: Ask, and ye shall be granted; seek, and ye shall find; knock, and it shall be opened unto you.

A.2 The Church

Witnesses: Schwäbisch Hall 1526, Schwäbisch Hall 1543, Frankfurt 1553, Neckarbischofsheim 1560 and Frankfurt 1589.

Bid. Hereupon let us diligently pray for the common Christian Church, and for the ministers of the Church, that the Lord our God would defend them against all the assaults and temptation of the wicked enemy, that they may abide steadfast upon the strong rock, our Lord Christ. Pray ye thus:

Prayer. Almighty, everlasting God, who hast revealed thy grace unto all peoples through Jesus Christ and his Gospel: preserve, O Lord, the people of thy mercy, that thy Church together with her ministers, scattered abroad in the whole world, may serve thee with right faith and continue in the confession of thy name.

A.3 Civil authority

Witnesses: Schwäbisch Hall 1526, Schwäbisch Hall 1543, Frankfurt 1553, Neckarbischofsheim 1560 and Frankfurt 1589.

Bid. Let us also pray, by the commandment and bidding of our Lord Jesus Christ and of his apostles, for our most gracious Lord the Emperor, for all kings and officers of the temporal government, and especially for an honourable magistracy of this city, that we may lead a quiet and peaceable life in all godliness. Pray ye thus:

Prayer. Merciful, heavenly Father, in whose hand standeth the power and authority of all men, set of thee for the punishment of the wicked and the welfare of the godly, in whose hand also stand all the rights and laws of all kingdoms: we beseech thee, look graciously upon our Lord the Emperor and all his officers, and namely upon the magistracy of this city, that they may bear the temporal sword, committed unto them of thee, in faith, according to thy word and commandment.

A.4 The afflicted

Witnesses: Schwäbisch Hall 1526, Schwäbisch Hall 1543, Frankfurt 1553, Neckarbischofsheim 1560 and Frankfurt 1589.

Bid. Let us also pray God our Lord, that he would deliver the world from error, and also from sicknesses, dearth, imprisonment, death, and all adversity which by the wicked enemy is brought upon us unto our destruction. Pray ye thus:

Prayer. Almighty, everlasting God, the comfort of the sorrowful, the strength of the weak: let the prayer of all them that sigh unto thee in trouble and temptation come before thy face, through our Lord Jesus Christ, that every man may feel thy help and succour in the time of need.

A.5 Peace

Witnesses: Schwäbisch Hall 1526, Schwäbisch Hall 1543, Frankfurt 1553, Neckarbischofsheim 1560 and Frankfurt 1589.

Bid. Let us also pray for a common peace and for the amendment of all Christendom, that God would graciously endue us with temporal and everlasting peace. Pray ye thus:

Prayer. Almighty, everlasting God, Lord of heaven and earth, by whose Spirit all things are governed, by whose providence all things are ordered, the God of peace: we beseech thee through our Lord Jesus Christ, that thou wouldest forgive our sins and anoint us with the spirit of peace, that we may serve thee in fear and trembling, to the laud and praise of thy name.

A.6 Enemies

Witnesses: Schwäbisch Hall 1526, Schwäbisch Hall 1543 and Neckarbischofsheim 1560. *Schwäbisch Hall 1543 lacks the rubric.*

Rubric. For our enemies

Bid. Let us also pray for our enemies, that God would lead them into the knowledge of themselves and lead them away from their unrighteousness. Pray ye thus:

Prayer. Almighty, everlasting God, who hast commanded us to love our enemies and to pray for our persecutors: we cry heartily unto thee, that thou wouldest graciously visit our enemies, and give them a friendly and one-accorded mind and heart with us and with all Christendom.

A.7 Women with child

Witnesses: Schwäbisch Hall 1526, Schwäbisch Hall 1543, Frankfurt 1553, Neckarbischofsheim 1560 and Frankfurt 1589.

Bid. Let us also pray for all women with child, that God would graciously deliver them from the bonds of childbirth. Pray ye thus:

Prayer. Almighty, everlasting God and Father, Creator of all things, who hast graciously blessed man and woman, saying: Be fruitful and multiply; and hast made the woman's sorrow in bearing an holy cross through our Lord Jesus Christ: we beseech thee, Lord God, that thou wouldest preserve and keep the fruit of her womb, thine own creature, and suffer her not to perish under the cross of the painful birth, but graciously deliver her.

A.8 Fruits of the earth

Witnesses: Schwäbisch Hall 1526, Schwäbisch Hall 1543 and Neckarbischofsheim 1560. *Schwäbisch Hall 1543 lacks the rubric.*

Rubric. For the fruits of the earth

Bid. Let us also pray for the fruits of the earth, that God would bless them and let them prosper well for us. Pray ye thus:

Prayer. Almighty, merciful, everlasting God, who through thy word createst and blessest all things: we beseech thee that thou wouldest impart unto us the seed of thy word, our Lord Jesus Christ, and sow him in our heart, whereby there may be blessed unto us, with fruitful increase and godly use, all that serveth us for our bodily need.

A.9 Lord's Prayer

Witnesses: Schwäbisch Hall 1526 and Schwäbisch Hall 1543. *The rubric is in Schwäbisch Hall 1526 only.*

Rubric. Common prayer

Bid. Let us also pray besides for all things for which God our Lord will be prayed unto, saying an Our Father.

A.10 Lord's Prayer

Witnesses: Schwäbisch Hall 1526.

Rubric. The Lord's Prayer

Prayer. Our Father, which art in heaven, etc.

A.11 Creed

Witnesses: Schwäbisch Hall 1526.

Rubric. The confession of the faith

Prayer. I believe in God the Father Almighty.

A.12 Ten Commandments

Witnesses: Schwäbisch Hall 1526.

Rubric. The Ten Commandments

Prayer. The Lord spake all these words: I am the Lord, etc.

A.13 Special intercessions

Witnesses: Schwäbisch Hall 1526.

Rubric. This, then, were for the common prayer. Prayers might always be added thereto according to matters as they befall, with wars, pestilence, or special sicknesses, etc.

A.14 Communicants

Witnesses: Frankfurt 1589.

Prayer. Over and above all this we beseech thee, O Lord Jesu Christ, who art the founder and upholder of this Sacrament, that thou wouldest richly impart unto us, who appear here to receive the same, thy Holy Spirit according to thy manifold promise, who may strengthen and keep our hearts in undoubting faith in thy words, in true knowledge, repentance and sorrow for our sins, and in firm trust in thy sole satisfaction for the same, that we may be partakers, not unworthily but worthily, of the precious pledges of thy holy Body and Blood; for the honour of thy holy sufferings and death and of this thy holy Testament. Amen.

A.15 Blessing

Witnesses: Neckarbischofsheim 1560.

Rubric. Appendix.

Prayer. Believe, and ye are heard in heaven, as the Lord hath promised us: Whatsoever ye ask in your prayer, only believe that ye shall receive it, and it shall be done unto you. Herewith the Lord bless you and keep you; he show you his face and have mercy upon you, and give you his everlasting peace. Amen.

6.5 Family B1: Württemberg long form

Brenz's bidding-plus-collect scheme in its ducal form: a preface on prayer (Mt 18:19, 1 Tim 2), then biddings each followed by a collect; used chiefly on high feasts. Spread through Pfalz-Neuburg 1554 to the Palatinate, Zweibrücken, Veldenz and Leiningen.

- **Earliest witness (archetype):** Württemberg 1553, long form.
- **Tradition:** Lutheran.
- **Language:** German.
- **Form:** preface, then bidding + collect for each intention.
- **Place in the service (Württemberg 1553):** On Sundays and feast days immediately after the sermon; the Litany is the second form of the common prayer.

Year	Witness	Territory	Sehling	Form
1553	Württemberg, Große Kirchenordnung (Brenz)	Duchy of Württemberg	Sehling 16, I/29, pp. 256–258	bidding + collect
1556	Kurpfalz, Kirchenordnung (Ottheinrich)	Electoral Palatinate	Sehling 14, Regierungszeit Ottheinrichs, pp. 151–153	bidding + collect

Year	Witness	Territory	Sehling	Form
1557	Pfalz-Zweibrücken, Kirchenordnung (Pfalzgraf Wolfgang)	Palatinate-Zweibrücken (and Neuburg)	Sehling 18, I/5, pp. 193–195	bidding + collect
1566	Leiningen-Westerburg, Kirchenordnung (Graf Philipp)	County of Leiningen-Westerburg	Sehling 19, IV/3, pp. 254–255	preface + bidding + headed collects
1574	Pfalz-Veldenz, Kirchenordnung (Pfalzgraf Georg Johann)	Palatinate-Veldenz (Lützelstein)	Sehling 18, II/8, pp. 505–508	bidding + collect

Each bid ends "Bittend also:" (Pray ye thus:) and each collect "through our Lord Jesus Christ. Amen.", following the family's own majority (Introduction, Representative texts, rule 4).

B1.2 to B1.4 are not one sequence but two local insertions after the preface. B1.2 is Kurpfalz 1556's lead-in to the open confession and absolution, which that order places here. B1.3 and B1.4 are Pfalz-Veldenz 1574's own confession and absolution.

Not in the representative text (a minority reading of its category; see the Prayers sheet or the critical sheets): Pfalz-Veldenz 1574 no. 9 (Peace).

Sequence: B1.1 Exhortation / preface > B1.2 Confession of sins > B1.3 Confession of sins > B1.4 Confession of sins > B1.5 The Church > B1.6 Civil authority > B1.7 The afflicted > B1.8 The erring & unbelievers > B1.9 Peace > B1.10 Enemies > B1.11 Women with child > B1.12 Fruits of the earth > B1.13 Lord's Prayer.

B1.1 Exhortation / preface

Witnesses: Württemberg 1553, Kurpfalz 1556, Pfalz-Zweibrücken 1557, Leiningen-Westerburg 1566 and Pfalz-Veldenz 1574.

Rubric. The preface of the common prayer.

Bid. Forasmuch as we are gathered together in God’s name, and it is commanded us that we should call upon God in all our need and also make our intercession for every man, whereunto we have the promise of our dear Lord Christ: Where two of you shall agree on earth as touching any thing that they shall ask, it shall be done for them of my Father which is in heaven; and: Ask, and it shall be given you; seek, and ye shall find; knock, and it shall be opened unto you.

B1.2 Confession of sins

Witnesses: Kurpfalz 1556.

Bid. Hereupon, forasmuch as we neither can nor may come before the throne of the divine majesty in our prayer with a comforted conscience and sure faith, except we be first reconciled with God and received of him into grace; and we come by no other way unto reconciliation with God, but that we acknowledge our sins and believe that our sins are forgiven and remitted us for the sake of the only-begotten Son of God, our dear Lord Jesus Christ: let us therefore first confess our sins before God and thereafter receive the absolution from our sins, saying thus: I, poor sinner, etc., as above.

B1.3 Confession of sins

Witnesses: Pfalz-Veldenz 1574.

Rubric. Confession and acknowledgement.

Bid. That our prayer be not despised and cast away of God, as flowing out of an unclean, impenitent heart, we will first of all confess our sins and misdeeds unto the Almighty with true repentance and sorrow, and in the name of his beloved Son Jesus Christ pray for pardon out of true faith. Therefore lift up your hearts and say with me this open confession:

Prayer. I, a poor, wretched, sinful man, confess before God, my Creator and Redeemer, that I, alas, have oft and many times sinned right grievously, not only with gross outward words and works, but much more with inward, inborn blindness, weakness, doubting, impatience, hatred and envy, covetousness, pride and haughtiness, and with other evil wiles, which my heavenly Father

well knoweth in me, and which I, alas, cannot so perfectly know. But they repent me from my heart and grieve me; I desire also from my heart grace and pardon of God, for the sake of his beloved Son, our Lord and Redeemer Jesus Christ, who hath shed his innocent blood for the sins of the whole world.

B1.4 Confession of sins

Witnesses: Pfalz-Veldenz 1574.

Rubric. Absolution.

Prayer. The almighty, merciful God hath had mercy upon us, and forgiveth us truly all our sins for the sake of his dear Son, our Lord Jesus Christ, whom he gave into death for our sakes, and hath given power to become the children of God to all that believe on his name; he giveth us moreover his Holy Spirit, that we may believe and be saved. This grant us God, Father, Son and Holy Ghost. Amen.

B1.5 The Church

Witnesses: Württemberg 1553, Kurpfalz 1556, Pfalz-Zweibrücken 1557, Leiningen-Westerburg 1566 and Pfalz-Veldenz 1574.

Bid. Hereupon let us, out of true confidence in the divine mercy, through our Lord Jesus Christ, pray for the common Christian Church and the ministers thereof. Pray ye thus:

Prayer. O almighty, gracious God and Father of our Lord Jesus Christ, who hath first commanded us that we should pray thee for labourers into thine harvest: we beseech thy bottomless mercy that thou wouldest send us right and true teachers and ministers of thy divine word, and give thy wholesome word into their heart and mouth, that they may faithfully perform thy commandment and preach nothing that is contrary to thy holy word; to the end that we, being by thy heavenly, eternal word admonished, taught, fed, comforted and strengthened, may do that which is well-pleasing unto thee and profitable unto us. Give, O Lord, unto thy holy Christendom thy Spirit and divine wisdom, that thy word may run and grow among us and be preached with all boldness, as it becometh, and that thy holy Christian congregation may be bettered thereby; that we may serve thee with steadfast faith and continue in the knowledge of thy name unto the end. Amen.

B1.6 Civil authority

Witnesses: Württemberg 1553, Kurpfalz 1556, Pfalz-Zweibrücken 1557, Leiningen-Westerburg 1566 and Pfalz-Veldenz 1574. *Leiningen-Westerburg 1566 lacks the bid.*

Rubric. For the temporal magistrates.

Bid. Let us faithfully pray, by the commandment of our Lord Jesus Christ and of his Apostles, for all temporal magistrates, that we may lead a quiet and still life in all godliness. Pray ye thus:

Prayer. Almighty, everlasting God, in whose hand standeth all power and authority of men, ordained of thee for the punishment of the wicked and the welfare of the godly, in whose hand also stand all the rights and laws of all realms upon earth: we beseech thee, look graciously upon thy servants, the Roman Emperor, all kings, princes and lawful magistrates, and especially upon our gracious prince and lord of this land, and also all his counsellors and officers, that they may bear the temporal sword, committed unto them of thee, according to thy commandment in thy fear. Enlighten them and keep them in thy divine name; give them, dear Lord, wisdom and understanding and a peaceable government, that they may defend and rule all their subjects in peace, rest and unity; and prolong their days, O God of our salvation, that under their dominion we together with them may hallow and praise thy divine name; through our Lord Jesus Christ. Amen.

B1.7 The afflicted

Witnesses: Württemberg 1553, Kurpfalz 1556, Pfalz-Zweibrücken 1557, Leiningen-Westerburg 1566 and Pfalz-Veldenz 1574. *Leiningen-Westerburg 1566 lacks the bid.*

Rubric. For all manner of trouble and temptation.

Bid. Let us pray for all them that are in trouble and temptation by reason of sickness, dearth, war, imprisonment, pestilence, and are burdened and laden with all manner of adversity, that God would graciously show them help and succour in their need. Pray ye thus:

Prayer. O almighty Lord God, who despisest not the sighing of the wretched, and settest not at nought the desire of the sorrowful hearts: look thou upon our prayer, which we bring before thee in our need, and hear us graciously, that all that striveth against us, both from the devil and from men, may be brought to nought and by the grace of thy goodness be scattered; that we, being hurt by no temptation, may give thanks unto thee in thy congregation and praise thee evermore; through our Lord Jesus Christ. Amen.

B1.8 The erring & unbelievers

Witnesses: Pfalz-Veldenz 1574.

Rubric. For them that are in error of the faith, that God would graciously convert them, etc.

Prayer. Lord God, heavenly Father, who willest that all men come to the knowledge of thee and be saved: we pray thee earnestly and with our whole heart that thou wouldest visit in fatherly wise all them that are fallen away from the Christian faith, or else are erring in certain articles and are possessed and led astray with false doctrine, and bring them again to the knowledge of their error, that they may win delight and pleasure in thy steadfast, simple, eternal truth; through our Lord Jesus Christ. Amen.

B1.9 Peace

Witnesses: Württemberg 1553, Kurpfalz 1556, Pfalz-Zweibrücken 1557, Leiningen-Westerburg 1566 and Pfalz-Veldenz 1574. *Leiningen-Westerburg 1566 lacks the bid.*

Rubric. For the common peace.

Bid. Let us also pray right earnestly for a common peace in the land, that the true service of God may grow up among us and Christian discipline increase. Pray ye thus:

Prayer. Almighty, everlasting God, a King of glory and a Lord of heaven and of earth, by whose Spirit all things are governed, by whose providence all things are ordered; who art a God of peace, from whom alone all unity cometh unto us: we beseech thee through our Lord Jesus Christ that thou wouldest forgive us our sins and endue us with thy divine peace and unity, that we may serve thee in fear and trembling, to the laud and praise of thy name. Amen.

B1.10 Enemies

Witnesses: Württemberg 1553, Kurpfalz 1556, Pfalz-Zweibrücken 1557, Leiningen-Westerburg 1566 and Pfalz-Veldenz 1574. *Leiningen-Westerburg 1566 and Pfalz-Veldenz 1574 lack the bid.*

Rubric. For the enemies.

Bid. Let us also pray for our enemies, that God would remember them with grace and graciously vouchsafe them that which is profitable and needful to their salvation. Pray ye thus:

Prayer. Almighty, everlasting God, who hast commanded us that we should love our enemies, do good to them that hurt us, and pray for our persecutors: we cry earnestly unto thee that thou wouldest graciously visit all our enemies, vouchsafe them true repentance of their sins, and give them, together with us and the whole of Christendom, a friendly, God-fearing, and single mind and heart; through our Lord Jesus Christ. Amen.

B1.11 Women with child

Witnesses: Württemberg 1553, Kurpfalz 1556, Pfalz-Zweibrücken 1557, Leiningen-Westerburg 1566 and Pfalz-Veldenz 1574. *Leiningen-Westerburg 1566 and Pfalz-Veldenz 1574 lack the bid.*

Rubric. For all women with child.

Bid. Let us also pray for all women with child, that God would graciously deliver them from the bonds of childbirth. Pray ye thus:

Prayer. Almighty, everlasting God and Father, a Creator of all things, who hast graciously blessed man and woman, and hast blessed unto the woman her pains in bearing to be an holy cross: we beseech thee, gracious Father, that thou wouldest keep and preserve the fruits of their womb, and not let it perish under the cross in the sorrowful travail, but graciously and with joy make them to feel thy help; through our Lord Jesus Christ. Amen.

B1.12 Fruits of the earth

Witnesses: Württemberg 1553, Kurpfalz 1556, Pfalz-Zweibrücken 1557, Leiningen-Westerburg 1566 and Pfalz-Veldenz 1574. *Leiningen-Westerburg 1566 lacks the bid.*

Rubric. For the fruits of the earth.

Bid. Let us also pray for the fruits of the earth, that God would bless them and graciously vouchsafe them unto us, to enjoy the same in obedience unto him. Pray ye thus:

Prayer. Almighty, everlasting God, who by thy word createst and blessest all things: we beseech thee that thou wouldest plant thy Word, our Lord Jesus Christ, in our heart, whereby all that serveth us for our bodily need may be blessed unto us with fruitful increase and godly use; through our Lord Jesus Christ. Amen.

B1.13 Lord's Prayer

Witnesses: Württemberg 1553, Kurpfalz 1556, Pfalz-Zweibrücken 1557 and Pfalz-Veldenz 1574.

Bid. Let us also pray for all that for which our Lord God will be prayed, saying: Our Father, etc.

6.6 Family B2: Württemberg short form

The same intentions compressed into a single continuous prayer ("Almighty, eternal God, heavenly Father …") after a brief exhortation; the ordinary Sunday form. The most widely copied general prayer in the corpus, reaching Saxony (1580), Magdeburg, Strasbourg, Sayn, Nassau and the Ysenburg counties.

- **Earliest witness (archetype):** Württemberg 1553, short form.
- **Tradition:** Lutheran.
- **Language:** German.
- **Form:** exhortation + one continuous prayer.
- **Place in the service (Württemberg 1553):** After the sermon, when time does not allow the long form to be read.

Year	Witness	Territory	Sehling	Form
1553	Württemberg, Große Kirchenordnung (Brenz)	Duchy of Württemberg	Sehling 16, I/29, pp. 261–262	exhortation + continuous prayer
1556	Kurpfalz, Kirchenordnung (Ottheinrich)	Electoral Palatinate	Sehling 14, Regierungszeit Ottheinrichs, pp. 157–159	exhortation + continuous prayer
1557	Pfalz-Zweibrücken, Kirchenordnung (Pfalzgraf Wolfgang)	Palatinate-Zweibrücken (and Neuburg)	Sehling 18, I/5, pp. 195–196	exhortation + continuous prayer
1559	Rothenburg ob der Tauber, Kirchenordnung	Rothenburg ob der Tauber (Imperial city)	Sehling 11, VI.1, pp. 587–588	exhortation + continuous prayer
1562	Erzstift Magdeburg, Visitationsordnung 1562 (Administrator Sigismund of Brandenburg)	Archbishopric of Magdeburg	Sehling 2, Erzbisthum Magdeburg Nr. 1, p. 420	prescription of contents (indirect speech)
1574	Pfalz-Veldenz, Kirchenordnung (Pfalzgraf Georg Johann)	Palatinate-Veldenz (Lützelstein)	Sehling 18, II/8, pp. 508–509	exhortation + continuous prayer

Year	Witness	Territory	Sehling	Form
1578	Hohenlohe, Kirchenordnung	County of Hohenlohe	Sehling 15, Nr. 25, pp. 263–264	exhortation + continuous prayer
1579	Nördlingen, Kirchenordnung	Nördlingen (Imperial city)	Sehling 12, VIII.7, pp. 367–368	exhortation + continuous prayer
1580	Kursachsen, Kirchenordnung (Kurfürst August)	Electorate of Saxony	Sehling 1, II. Theil, Nr. 40, pp. 370–371	exhortation + continuous prayer
1582	Ysenburg-Ronneburg, Agende	County of Ysenburg-Ronneburg	Sehling 10, III/Ysenburg-Ronneburg Nr. 3, pp. 575–576	confession + continuous prayer
1588	Ysenburg-Birstein, Kirchenordnung	County of Ysenburg-Büdingen-Birstein	Sehling 10, III/Ysenburg-Birstein Nr. 14, pp. 621–622	exhortation + confession + continuous prayer
1590	Sayn, Kirchenordnung 1590 (Graf Heinrich IV.)	County of Sayn	Sehling 19, V/18, pp. 408–410	preface + continuous prayer
1598	Straßburg, Kirchenordnung (9 April 1598)	Strasbourg (Imperial city)	Sehling 20/1, Nr. 61, pp. 588–589	exhortation + continuous prayer
1603	Wild- und Rheingrafschaft, Kirchenordnung [nach 1603]	Wild- and Rhinegraviate (Salm-Kyrburg, Dhaun, Grumbach)	Sehling 19, VII/21, pp. 622–623	exhortation + confession + absolution + continuous prayer + Lord’s Prayer
1605	Pfalz-Veldenz, Kirchenordnung Lützelstein	Palatinate-Veldenz (Lützelstein)	Sehling 18, II/11, pp. 585–586	continuous prayer
1618	Nassau-Weilburg (Nassau-Saarbrücken), Kirchenordnung und Agende 1617/1618	Counties of Nassau-Weilburg and Saarbrücken	Sehling 10, I/Nassau-Weilburg Nr. 1 (appendix: KO 1617, Agende 1618), p. 314	continuous prayer
1618	Rothenberg, Vereinigung, wie es mit den kirchenactibus soll gehalten werden	Ganerbschaft Rothenberg (Franconia)	Sehling 13, V.1–2, pp. 548–549	continuous prayer

Magdeburg 1562 prescribes the contents of the prayer in indirect speech ("that he also [would grant] to the temporal magistrates …"). Where no other witness has a bid, its sentences fill the bid column. B2.2 is its opening, and the bids of B2.6 and B2.9 are its words. They are paraphrases of the prayer, not words said to the people.

The confession and absolution (B2.3, B2.4) are those of the Ysenburg orders of 1582 and 1588 and the Wild- und Rheingrafschaft 1603. B2.12, B2.13 and B2.15 each come from a single witness (Rothenberg 1618, Rothenburg 1559, Nördlingen 1579) and stand where that order has them.

Not in the representative text (a minority reading of its category; see the Prayers sheet or the critical sheets): Hohenlohe 1578 no. 1 (Exhortation / preface); Nördlingen 1579 no. 1 (Exhortation / preface); Ysenburg-Birstein 1588 no. 1 (Exhortation / preface); Sayn 1590 no. 1 (Exhortation / preface); Strassburg 1598 no. 1 (Exhortation / preface); Strassburg 1598 no. 8 (Special intercessions); Wild- und Rheingrafschaft 1603 no. 1 (Exhortation / preface); Wild- und Rheingrafschaft 1603 no. 3 (Confession of sins); Wild- und Rheingrafschaft 1603 no. 10 (Lord's Prayer); Lützelstein 1605 no. 1 (Special intercessions).

Sequence: B2.1 Exhortation / preface > B2.2 Thanksgiving > B2.3 Confession of sins > B2.4 Confession of sins > B2.5 The Church > B2.6 Civil authority > B2.7 Enemies > B2.8 The erring & unbelievers > B2.9 The afflicted > B2.10 Fruits of the earth > B2.11 Conclusion > B2.12 Communicants > B2.13 Lord's Prayer > B2.14 Lord's Prayer > B2.15 Special intercessions.

B2.1 Exhortation / preface

Witnesses: Württemberg 1553, Kurpfalz 1556, Pfalz-Zweibrücken 1557, Rothenburg 1559, Pfalz-Veldenz 1574, Nördlingen 1579 and Kursachsen 1580.

Rubric. A shorter form of the common prayer. But forasmuch as it cometh to pass at times that the prayers cannot well be rehearsed at length, then may the following prayer, wherein all the concerns of the Church are briefly comprehended, be said after the sermon:

Bid. Dearly beloved in Christ, forasmuch as we are all members of one body, whereof Christ is the head, so ought one member to take the part of another and to pray one for another; and this we should do gladly from the heart, by the commandment of our Lord Christ and of his holy Apostle. Pray ye thus:

B2.2 Thanksgiving

Witnesses: Magdeburg 1562.

Rubric. How they hold the common prayer. (In the margin: Reminder concerning the common prayer.)

Bid. And the ministers of the Church in the villages and in the small towns here shall be reminded by our visitors that in the common prayer, which is always made after the sermon, they give thanks unto the merciful God for the revelation and preservation of his divine word,

B2.3 Confession of sins

Witnesses: Ysenburg-Ronneburg 1582, Ysenburg-Birstein 1588 and Wild- und Rheingrafschaft 1603. *The bid is in Ysenburg-Ronneburg 1582 only.*

Bid. Confess with me your sins before God; say from the heart:

Prayer. Lord God, heavenly Father, I, a poor sinful man, confess before thee that I, alas, have sinned grievously and much against thee with words, works, thoughts, doing and leaving undone, as thou, O God, knowest it in me, and I, alas, cannot confess it. It repenteth me and grieveth me from my heart. I desire grace and forgiveness of my sins through Jesus Christ thy dear Son.

B2.4 Confession of sins

Witnesses: Ysenburg-Ronneburg 1582 and Ysenburg-Birstein 1588.

Prayer. To all them that are heartily sorry for their sins, fear and are affrighted before God's wrath, but desire grace and believe on Jesus Christ, and purpose to amend their life, unto them I declare by the commandment of God that God will have mercy upon them, pardon their sins, and give them eternal life for the sake of Jesus Christ his dear Son. But they that acknowledge not their sins, fear not God's wrath, but continue and go on in sins with impenitence, and believe not on Jesus Christ, but trust in their own works and worthiness or in aught else apart from Christ: upon them the wrath of God abideth until the time of their amendment.

B2.5 The Church

Witnesses: Württemberg 1553, Kurpfalz 1556, Pfalz-Zweibrücken 1557, Rothenburg 1559, Magdeburg 1562, Pfalz-Veldenz 1574, Hohenlohe 1578, Nördlingen 1579, Kursachsen 1580, Ysenburg-Ronneburg 1582, Ysenburg-Birstein 1588, Sayn 1590, Strassburg 1598, Wild- und Rheingrafschaft 1603, Lützelstein 1605, Nassau-Weilburg 1618 and Rothenberg 1618. *The bid is in Magdeburg 1562, Ysenburg-Ronneburg 1582, Ysenburg-Birstein 1588 and Wild- und Rheingrafschaft 1603 only. Magdeburg 1562 lacks the prayer.*

Bid. Let us pray:

Prayer. Almighty, merciful, everlasting God and Father, a Lord of heaven and of earth: we beseech thee heartily that thou wouldest govern thy holy Church with her ministers by the Holy Ghost, that they may be kept in the right and true pasture of

thine almighty and everlasting word, whereby faith toward thee may be strengthened, and love toward all men may spring up and increase in us.

B2.6 Civil authority

Witnesses: Württemberg 1553, Kurpfalz 1556, Pfalz-Zweibrücken 1557, Rothenburg 1559, Magdeburg 1562, Pfalz-Veldenz 1574, Hohenlohe 1578, Nördlingen 1579, Kursachsen 1580, Ysenburg-Ronneburg 1582, Ysenburg-Birstein 1588, Sayn 1590, Strassburg 1598, Wild- und Rheingrafschaft 1603, Lützelstein 1605, Nassau-Weilburg 1618 and Rothenberg 1618. *The bid is in Magdeburg 1562 only. Magdeburg 1562 lacks the prayer.*

Bid. that he would also vouchsafe unto the temporal magistrates, the Roman Emperor, all Christian kings, Electors, princes and lords, but especially unto us as prince of the land, our kind and dearly beloved consort, the young lordship and damsels, and also the whole most laudable Electoral and princely house of Brandenburg, long life, abiding health and prosperous government, together with all temporal and eternal welfare; and likewise unto all our counsellors and officers understanding, grace and unity to rule the subjects according to his divine will and good pleasure, that righteousness may be furthered and wickedness hindered and punished, that we may accomplish our life in quiet rest and good peace, as becometh Christians;

Prayer. Vouchsafe also unto the temporal magistrates, the Roman Emperor, all kings, princes and lords, but especially unto our gracious lord and prince of this land, and also the whole house of Württemberg, together with all their counsellors and officers, grace and unity to rule the subjects according to thy divine will and good pleasure; that righteousness may be furthered, and wickedness hindered and punished, that we may accomplish our life in quiet rest and good peace, as becometh Christians.

B2.7 Enemies

Witnesses: Württemberg 1553, Kurpfalz 1556, Pfalz-Zweibrücken 1557, Rothenburg 1559, Pfalz-Veldenz 1574, Hohenlohe 1578, Nördlingen 1579, Kursachsen 1580, Ysenburg-Ronneburg 1582, Ysenburg-Birstein 1588, Sayn 1590, Strassburg 1598, Wild- und Rheingrafschaft 1603, Lützelstein 1605, Nassau-Weilburg 1618 and Rothenberg 1618.

Prayer. That our enemies and adversaries also may desist, and yield themselves to live with us peaceably and gently.

B2.8 The erring & unbelievers

Witnesses: Pfalz-Veldenz 1574 and Lützelstein 1605.

Prayer. And all that err, are led astray, and are apostate, wilt thou, O gracious God, bring to the truth of thy word and the knowledge of thy holy name.

B2.9 The afflicted

Witnesses: Württemberg 1553, Kurpfalz 1556, Pfalz-Zweibrücken 1557, Rothenburg 1559, Magdeburg 1562, Pfalz-Veldenz 1574, Hohenlohe 1578, Nördlingen 1579, Kursachsen 1580, Ysenburg-Ronneburg 1582, Ysenburg-Birstein 1588, Sayn 1590, Strassburg 1598, Wild- und Rheingrafschaft 1603, Lützelstein 1605, Nassau-Weilburg 1618 and Rothenberg 1618. *The bid is in Magdeburg 1562 only. Magdeburg 1562 lacks the prayer.*

Bid. and, as the form of the common prayer is further wont to go, for the fruits of the earth, for all the sorrowful, poor and sick that are assailed by the devil or by men, for them that for his holy name's sake and for the truth's sake are taken captive or otherwise suffer persecution, and whatsoever more there be of like tribulation and burden.

Prayer. All them that are in tribulation, poverty, sickness, the bonds of childbirth, and other temptation, and them also that for thy holy name's sake and for the truth's sake are assailed, taken captive, or otherwise suffer persecution: comfort them, O God, with thy Holy Spirit, that they may receive and acknowledge all this as thy fatherly will.

B2.10 Fruits of the earth

Witnesses: Württemberg 1553, Kurpfalz 1556, Pfalz-Zweibrücken 1557, Rothenburg 1559, Pfalz-Veldenz 1574, Hohenlohe 1578, Nördlingen 1579, Kursachsen 1580, Ysenburg-Ronneburg 1582, Ysenburg-Birstein 1588, Sayn 1590, Strassburg 1598, Wild- und Rheingrafschaft 1603, Lützelstein 1605, Nassau-Weilburg 1618 and Rothenberg 1618.

Prayer. Cause also all the fruits of the earth that pertain to our bodily need to prosper and thrive for us with fruitful increase.

B2.11 Conclusion

Witnesses: Württemberg 1553, Kurpfalz 1556, Pfalz-Zweibrücken 1557, Rothenburg 1559, Pfalz-Veldenz 1574, Hohenlohe 1578, Nördlingen 1579, Kursachsen 1580, Ysenburg-Ronneburg 1582, Ysenburg-Birstein 1588, Sayn 1590, Strassburg 1598, Wild- und Rheingrafschaft 1603, Lützelstein 1605, Nassau-Weilburg 1618 and Rothenberg 1618.

Prayer. We pray also for all that for which thou, everlasting God, wilt be prayed, that thou wouldest graciously vouchsafe us the same, through the bitter suffering and death of Christ Jesus, thine only Son, our beloved Lord and Saviour, who with thee and the Holy Ghost liveth and reigneth, equal God, highly praised, for ever. Amen.

B2.12 Communicants

Witnesses: Rothenberg 1618.

Rubric. Note. When there are communicants, one shall not omit to pray for them also, that they may receive the holy Supper unto life in true knowledge and repentance of their sins, in saving faith in Christ, and in a Christian purpose to amend their life.

B2.13 Lord's Prayer

Witnesses: Rothenburg 1559.

Rubric. And let every one say an Our Father thereupon.

B2.14 Lord's Prayer

Witnesses: Pfalz-Veldenz 1574, Hohenlohe 1578, Ysenburg-Ronneburg 1582, Ysenburg-Birstein 1588, Lützelstein 1605 and Nassau-Weilburg 1618. *Hohenlohe 1578 lacks the prayer.*

Prayer. Our Father, etc.

B2.15 Special intercessions

Witnesses: Nördlingen 1579.

Rubric. Thereupon the special needs that befall, as the sick, the publishing of the married folk, feast days, etc., are to be announced, and it is to be concluded with the Our Father, together with the blessing:

Prayer. The grace of our Lord Jesus Christ, and the love of God, and the communion of the Holy Ghost, be with you all. Amen.

6.7 Family C: Bidding exhortation (Strasbourg type)

A bidding exhortation in the Strasbourg manner: the minister tells the people what to pray for, item by item, without addressing God, and ends with the Our Father.

- **Earliest witness (archetype):** Hanau-Lichtenberg 1573.
- **Tradition:** Lutheran.
- **Language:** German.
- **Form:** bidding exhortation + Our Father.
- **Place in the service (Hanau-Lichtenberg 1573):** After the sermon; then a psalm is sung by school and congregation, followed by a collect and the blessing. The pastor is to refer to the sermon just preached and to present needs (war, plague, dearth) in the common prayer.

Year	Witness	Territory	Sehling	Form
1573	Hanau-Lichtenberg, Kirchenordnung (Graf Philipp	County of Hanau-Lichtenberg (Alsace)	Sehling 20/2, Hanau-Lichtenberg Nr. 6, pp. 52–53	bidding exhortation + Lord’s Prayer

Year	Witness	Territory	Sehling	Form
	IV.)			

Sequence: C.1 Exhortation / preface > C.2 The Word & its fruit > C.3 Civil authority > C.4 All estates / households > C.5 Fruits of the earth > C.6 The afflicted > C.7 Special intercessions > C.8 Lord's Prayer.

C.1 Exhortation / preface

Rubric. After the sermon let the common prayer be made on this wise:

Bid. Dear friends, forasmuch as we are gathered together and have heard God’s word, we will lay all the need of the whole of Christendom before our Lord God, and pray him that he would be gracious and merciful unto us, and give all that is profitable and needful for us, for the necessity of the body and for the salvation of the soul:

C.2 The Word & its fruit

Bid. First, pray ye for the spiritual estate: that our dear Lord God would let his holy word be preached unto us, and vouchsafe grace that we may gladly hear the same, believe it with the heart, and order our life thereafter; and that he would comfort, strengthen, and deliver out of all misery and woe all those that for the sake of this Word are in misery, woe and adversity. That he would also graciously enlighten by his Word and Holy Spirit all that are yet in darkness, error and idolatry, and bring them to the knowledge of the truth, that they with us and we with them may be saved.

C.3 Civil authority

Bid. Secondly, pray ye for the temporal government: first for the head, his Roman Imperial Majesty, our most gracious lord; then for the members, as the Electors, princes and lords of all Christendom; but especially for our gracious lords, lady and damsels of Hanau, for their Graces’ counsellors, officers, servants and the whole lordship, for a worshipful court and commune here, and also the neighbourhood round about. Almighty God vouchsafe unto the magistrates his Holy Spirit and wisdom, that they may rule in Christian wise and well, and keep and preserve the subjects in common peace.

C.4 All estates / households

Bid. Lastly, pray ye also for the estate of matrimony: Almighty God vouchsafe unto all married folk his Holy Spirit, that they may live together in Christian wise, peaceably and in concord, and may bring up their children and household in the fear of God, and also in honour and virtue.

C.5 Fruits of the earth

Bid. Pray ye for the fruit of the field, for seasonable weather, and for all that is needful unto us.

C.6 The afflicted

Bid. May our Lord God tend and keep children and the sick, give unto women with child and them that give suck joyful fruit and increase, and loose and set free the captives.

C.7 Special intercessions

Bid. And let every man consider his own need and come with it before God, the heavenly Father, and doubt not that he will graciously hear us through Christ. And say with your whole heart thus:

C.8 Lord's Prayer

Prayer. Our Father, which art in heaven, Hallowed be thy name. Thy kingdom come. Thy will be done in earth, as it is in heaven. Give us this day our daily bread. And forgive us our debts, as we forgive our debtors. And lead us not into temptation, but deliver us from evil: For thine is the kingdom, and the power, and the glory, from everlasting to everlasting. Amen.

6.8 Family D: Nürnberg-type Vermahnung zum Gebet

"Vermahnung zum Gebet" (Exhortation to prayer): an exhortation in the second person ("Dear friends, pray …") listing the intentions, closed by the Our Father. Copied in Waldeck, Erbach, Solms-Laubach and Henneberg.

- **Earliest witness (archetype):** Nürnberg 1545 (Veit Dietrich).
- **Tradition:** Lutheran.
- **Language:** German.
- **Form:** bidding exhortation + Our Father.
- **Place in the service (Nürnberg 1545):** In the “Order of the Mass in the country, where there are no schools”: after the opening German psalm the pastor reads, in place of the Epistle, this exhortation with the Our Father, followed by the Creed, the Ten Commandments and the catechism pieces on Baptism, the Keys and the Supper (the medieval pulpit office, Prone).

Year	Witness	Territory	Sehling	Form
1545	Nürnberg, Agendbüchlein für die Pfarrherren auf dem Land (Veit Dietrich)	Nürnberg (Imperial city) and its rural parishes	Sehling 11, V.1, pp. 500–501	bidding exhortation + Lord’s Prayer
1556	Waldeck, Kirchenordnung (Kirchen Ordnung auff den Dörffern)	County of Waldeck	Sehling 9, II/Waldeck Nr. 15 (Kirchenordnung 1556), pp. 273–274	bidding exhortation + Lord’s Prayer
1560	Erbach, Kirchenordnung (Graf Georg)	County of Erbach	Sehling 9, IV/Erbach Nr. 6 (2. Erbacher Kirchenordnung 1560), pp. 428–429	bidding exhortation + Lord’s Prayer
1576	Solms-Laubach, Kirchenordnung [1576–1580]	County of Solms-Laubach	Sehling 9, III/Solms Nr. 10, pp. 360–361	bidding exhortation + Lord’s Prayer
1582	Henneberg, Kirchenordnung (Graf Georg Ernst)	County of Henneberg	Sehling 2, Henneberg Nr. 3, p. 308	bidding exhortation + Lord’s Prayer

The family has two lines, and the representative text joins them. Veit Dietrich's exhortation (Nürnberg 1545, copied in Waldeck 1556) supplies D.3, D.7, D.12 and D.14. The Erbach line (Erbach 1560, Solms-Laubach 1576, Henneberg 1582) supplies most of the rest, and it has the majority for the magistrates (D.6). So the text has two openings: D.3 (Nürnberg) and D.4 (Erbach). To read Veit Dietrich's prayer alone, use the Prayers sheet of the workbook, or the critical sheets.

Not in the representative text (a minority reading of its category; see the Prayers sheet or the critical sheets): Nürnberg 1545 no. 2 (Civil authority); Waldeck 1556 no. 2 (Civil authority); Erbach 1560 no. 7 (All estates / households); Erbach 1560 no. 8 (Lord's Prayer); Solms-Laubach 1576 no. 5 (All estates / households); Solms-Laubach 1576 no. 7 (Special intercessions); Henneberg 1582 no. 5 (All estates / households); Henneberg 1582 no. 9 (Special intercessions).

Sequence: D.1 Exhortation / preface > D.2 Thanksgiving > D.3 The Word & its fruit > D.4 The Church > D.5 Peace > D.6 Civil authority > D.7 All estates / households > D.8 The persecuted > D.9 The afflicted > D.10 The erring & unbelievers > D.11 Women with child > D.12 Lord's Prayer > D.13 Special intercessions > D.14 Creed > D.15 Blessing.

D.1 Exhortation / preface

Witnesses: Henneberg 1582.

Rubric. After the sermon the minister shall again diligently exhort the people to prayer for all estates and the need of the Christian Church by means of the following form. ¶ Form of the common prayer.

Bid. Beloved in the Lord Christ, forasmuch as we are now here gathered together in the name of our Lord Christ, and have God’s commandment and bidding that we should pray, and moreover the promise that whatsoever we ask in the name of Jesus Christ,

our gracious Father in heaven will gladly give it us:

D.2 Thanksgiving

Witnesses: Solms-Laubach 1576.

Rubric. At the end of the sermon the matters handled shall be briefly repeated, and then, if there be persons that have given in their names as betrothed one to another, they shall be proclaimed; whereupon thanksgiving and prayer shall follow, thus: ¶ Thanksgiving and common prayer

Bid. Forasmuch now as we have heard God's word, and are bound to give thanks unto God Almighty for all his benefits which he daily showeth us, we will give him thanks for the work of creation, redemption and sanctification; that he still keepeth us evermore in his knowledge until the last day, and vouchsafeth his grace to the spiritual, temporal and household estate, and blesseth us. We are bound also to pray for the preservation of the same estates and what pertaineth thereto; and we have God's promise and sure assurance that whatsoever we shall ask in the name of Jesus Christ, the Father in heaven will give it us.

D.3 The Word & its fruit

Witnesses: Nürnberg 1545 and Waldeck 1556.

Rubric. Exhortation to pray for all manner of estates:

Bid. Ye elect, pray God the Father of all mercy, through Jesus Christ our dear Lord, for the fruitful increase of the holy Gospel, that he would send right and true labourers into his harvest, and graciously enlighten both ministers and hearers of the word, to the hallowing of his blessed name, the increase of his kingdom and the fulfilling of his divine will.

D.4 The Church

Witnesses: Erbach 1560, Solms-Laubach 1576 and Henneberg 1582.

Bid. Let us therefore first consider the need of all Christendom, and pray that God would keep his word pure and clear unto us, and also bring thereto them that are not yet come to the right knowledge, and graciously guard his poor Christendom against all the devices of the devil.

D.5 Peace

Witnesses: Erbach 1560, Solms-Laubach 1576 and Henneberg 1582.

Bid. Thereafter let us also pray for this temporal life, that God would bless us with gracious peace and seasonable weather, and keep us from dearth, war and pestilence.

D.6 Civil authority

Witnesses: Erbach 1560, Solms-Laubach 1576 and Henneberg 1582.

Bid. Pray ye also for all magistrates, Emperor, kings, princes and lords, especially for our gracious lordship here, that God would enlighten their hearts by his Spirit and word, that God's word and honour may be furthered and not hindered by them, and that we also may have the more peace under their government.

D.7 All estates / households

Witnesses: Nürnberg 1545 and Waldeck 1556.

Bid. Further, pray ye for all married folk, masters and mistresses of households, labourers, tradesmen, servants, sinners men and women, the sick, the captives, the sorrowful, forsaken widows and orphans, and them that are in temptation, sorrowful, erring and misled consciences, or whatsoever else there be of the like. The eternal, gracious God have mercy upon all, pardon their misdeeds, vouchsafe them an honourable, peaceable, honest conversation according to his word, and let them sink in no temptation, but graciously deliver them from all evil, be it bodily or ghostly, through pure doctrine and firm faith. Amen.

D.8 The persecuted

Witnesses: Erbach 1560 and Henneberg 1582.

Bid. Forasmuch also as here and there in all lands many poor Christians are for the word of God and for righteousness' sake persecuted, driven out, cast into prison, miserably tormented and slain, we are bound to pray God for them, that he would comfort and strengthen their hearts by his Holy Spirit, keep them steadfast in the confession, and help them blessedly in body and soul.

D.9 The afflicted

Witnesses: Erbach 1560, Solms-Laubach 1576 and Henneberg 1582.

Bid. Thereafter let us also pray for our poor brethren and sisters, here and in the whole world, where there is either grievous sickness or great temptation, that God would graciously deliver them.

D.10 The erring & unbelievers

Witnesses: Henneberg 1582.

Bid. Lastly pray ye also for the poor people that yet lie under the papacy in error and an evil conscience, and have not the blessed knowledge of the word as we have, that God would lead them also to such light of his grace and make them with us eternally blessed through right faith in Christ.

D.11 Women with child

Witnesses: Erbach 1560.

Bid. Pray ye also for all women with child, that they may be graciously delivered from the bonds of childbirth; for these and all other necessities of the whole of Christendom; and also for our enemies, that they may be converted and brought to the right knowledge of our Lord Jesus Christ.

D.12 Lord's Prayer

Witnesses: Nürnberg 1545, Waldeck 1556, Solms-Laubach 1576 and Henneberg 1582. *Solms-Laubach 1576 lacks the bid. The prayer is in Nürnberg 1545 and Solms-Laubach 1576 only.*

Bid. To obtain all this, say out of right faith:

Prayer. Our Father …, but deliver us from evil: for thine is the kingdom, and the power, and the glory, for ever. Amen.

D.13 Special intercessions

Witnesses: Erbach 1560.

Rubric. So also at any time, by reason of need befalling, as in wars, pestilence and dearth, special prayers serving thereto may for that time be added and used.

D.14 Creed

Witnesses: Nürnberg 1545.

Rubric. The articles of our faith.

Prayer. I believe in God the Father Almighty, Maker of heaven and earth, …

D.15 Blessing

Witnesses: Henneberg 1582.

Rubric. After such exhortation and the Our Father said, the preacher shall speak the following blessing over the people:

Prayer. The grace of our Lord Jesus Christ, the love of God, and the communion of the Holy Ghost be with you all. Amen.

6.9 Family E: Saxon Gemein Gebet (Melanchthon/Pfeffinger)

The Albertine Saxon "Gemein Gebet" (Common prayer) in the Melanchthon/Pfeffinger tradition, a continuous prayer with pronounced petitions against war and for the Elector.

- **Earliest witness (archetype):** Leipzig 1567.
- **Tradition:** Lutheran.
- **Language:** German.
- **Form:** continuous prayer.
- **Place in the service (Leipzig 1567):** After the sermon, “to be said with mouth and heart”.

Year	Witness	Territory	Sehling	Form
1567	Leipzig, Gemein gebet (renewed by Johann Pfeffinger)	Leipzig (Electoral Saxony)	Sehling 1, IV. Theil, Nr. 108, pp. 595–596	continuous prayer

Sequence: E.1 Repentance & forgiveness > E.2 The Church > E.3 Civil authority > E.4 Peace > E.5 Civil authority > E.6 The afflicted.

E.1 Repentance & forgiveness

Rubric. Common prayer. To be said after the sermon with mouth and heart.

Prayer. Almighty God and Father of our Lord Jesus Christ, we confess that we are defiled with many sins, wittingly and unwittingly, and it grieveth us heartily that we have done against thy righteous will; and we beseech thee that thou wouldest turn our hearts unto thee, and forgive us all our sins for thy dear Son Jesus Christ’s sake, and kindle in us by thy Holy Spirit right faith and right obedience, and govern us. So is it also our earnest purpose to amend ourselves with thy help and to live in thy obedience.

E.2 The Church

Prayer. We beseech thee also, for thy dear Son Jesus Christ’s sake, that thou wouldest evermore gather a Church among us in these lands, and preserve Christian pure doctrine, and give faithful teachers and preachers, which with right doctrine and good example may serve to thy praise and the salvation of the people.

E.3 Civil authority

Prayer. And we beseech thee from our heart that thou wouldest, for thy dear Son Jesus Christ’s sake, give unto these lands peaceable, Christian, blessed government, and govern with the Holy Spirit the Roman Imperial Majesty and our lordships, the duke regent Elector and his Electoral Grace’s adherents and kinsfolk, that their life and government may serve to thy praise, and to peace and salvation for them and for the subjects.

E.4 Peace

Prayer. Wilt thou also by thy bottomless mercy guard, protect and preserve his Electoral Grace, together with his adherents and kinsmen, in these grievous and other matters of war; graciously convert the adversaries, the unquiet and disobedient, which resist the divine ordinance, despise authority, break the peace, and give occasion to bloodshed and the ruin of people and land, or else restrain and withstand them; and bring the lawful war committed unto us to a good, happy, peaceable end with blessed welfare, that the innocent bloodshed of many Christians and the wasting of these lands, schools and churches may be turned away and prevented.

E.5 Civil authority

Prayer. And wilt thou also graciously govern and preserve the magistrates and subjects of this city, and willingly give and bless the fruits of the earth (which thou givest that men may be preserved in this bodily life, to learn to know thee and call upon thee) and our daily bread.

E.6 The afflicted

Prayer. Thou knowest also the great weakness of man's nature, and wilt therefore temper thy great wrath with mercy, for the sake of the merit and intercession of thy most dear Son Jesus Christ our Lord. Therefore we beseech thee that thou wouldest graciously temper our well-deserved punishments, and comfort with thy Holy Spirit all the sorrowful that call upon thee, that they may abide in right faith and right calling upon thee, and praise thy mercy for ever. Amen.

6.10 Family F: Upper German pulpit intercession (Strasbourg/Zürich)

Upper German (Bucerian/Zwinglian) intercession after the sermon, a continuous prayer with rubrics, related to Zürich 1535 and the Strasbourg forms.

- **Earliest witness (archetype):** Augsburg 1537.
- **Tradition:** Moderate Reformed (Upper German, Bucerian).
- **Language:** German.
- **Form:** continuous prayer with rubrics + Our Father.
- **Place in the service (Augsburg 1537):** At the end of the sermon service (after the Decalogue, confession, and the Creed); banns and requests for prayer are read within it.

Year	Witness	Territory	Sehling	Form
1537	Augsburg, Kirchenordnung (Die zehen gebot, Articul des Glaubens, Und das Vater unser) (Moderate Reformed)	Augsburg (Imperial city)	Sehling 12, I.8a, pp. 70–71	prayer with rubrics + Lord's Prayer

Sequence: F.1 Exhortation / preface > F.2 All men > F.3 Civil authority > F.4 Ministers of the Word > F.5 All estates / households > F.6 Special intercessions > F.7 Women with child > F.8 Schools & youth > F.9 All estates / households > F.10 The afflicted > F.11 Special intercessions > F.12 The persecuted > F.13 The erring & unbelievers > F.14 Against the Turk > F.15 Against the Turk > F.16 Lord's Prayer.

F.1 Exhortation / preface

Rubric. Intercession for the common estates:

Bid. But forasmuch as it is good and acceptable before God our Saviour, and he hath commanded us by his holy Apostle to pray for all men, let us in his name, wherein all good is promised us, come before God our gracious Father with true faith and hearty confidence, and say thus:

F.2 All men

Prayer. Almighty, everlasting God, dear and faithful Father in heaven: as thy great grace and goodness showeth itself richly toward all men, so, forasmuch as we are thy children, we desire from our hearts to take after thy fatherly bounty as far as may be, and to show forth our love toward all men in Christian wise by our faithful intercession, since we can do no more; and we call upon thee therefore, through thy Son Jesus Christ, our dear Lord and Saviour, for all the estates and concerns of thy holy Christendom.

F.3 Civil authority

Prayer. First for our lord the Emperor, the King, all princes, lords and rulers, but especially for our worshipful magistrates in this city. Vouchsafe unto them all the spirit of thy fear and wisdom, that they may order all their government to the praise and glory of thy great name and to the peaceable preservation of the subjects in all honesty and godliness. But unto the subjects give a willing and seemly heart to obey the magistrates in all that is not against thee.

F.4 Ministers of the Word

Prayer. We beseech thee also from our hearts, grant unto all ministers and preachers of thy holy word that with sound doctrine and unblameable life they may preside in Christian wise over thy holy congregation to its daily amendment. But especially, faithful Father, ordain graciously at all times all good means, that neither we nor our posterity may ever lack faithful stewards of thy mysteries and of the comfortable Gospel of thy Son Jesus Christ.

F.5 All estates / households

Prayer. Have mercy also, gracious God, upon all fathers and mothers of households, and also schoolmasters and all that have children or servants, that they may bring them up and govern them godly according to the direction of thy word, to thy praise and the profit of thy Church. Let also, dear God, thy peace and blessing prevail richly over all married folk, that they may dwell together in love and unity and bear all the burdens of wedlock with faith and patience. But especially vouchsafe this unto these persons that desire to bind themselves together in marriage, by name, etc.

F.6 Special intercessions

Rubric. Here the marriages shall be published, and then thereupon further said thus:

Prayer. Grant them, merciful Father, to enter upon this holy estate in thy fear, that they may also live therein in Christian wise and close the same blessedly.

F.7 Women with child

Prayer. Wilt thou also, O heavenly Father, graciously deliver women in travail and gladden them graciously with a well-formed fruit, well-pleasing unto thee.

F.8 Schools & youth

Prayer. We pray thee also, gracious Father, for our youth not yet brought up, that thou wouldest bring them up in fatherly wise by thy Holy Spirit and form them according to thy will and good pleasure, that they may grow up blessedly in thy fear and in faith in thy Son Jesus Christ, and that every service of thy congregation may evermore be well and christianly supplied by them.

F.9 All estates / households

Prayer. Give thy gracious increase and blessing to all faithful servants and labourers. Endow the poor with bodily sustenance and Christian resignation, the rich with faithful liberality.

F.10 The afflicted

Prayer. Show thyself a faithful and bountiful Father to all sorrowful hearts, tempted within or without. Grant unto the sick long-suffering patience, to the dying a joyful going up to heaven. And in especial have mercy upon certain which at this time in their suffering, sickness and tribulation desire our intercession.

F.11 Special intercessions

Rubric. Here he shall announce them that desire the common prayer, and thereupon say:

Prayer. Let all that befall them in fatherly wise, faithful God, which according to thy will they desire to obtain of thee through our intercession. Give them the comfort of thy grace, that in the midst of suffering and tribulation they may feel thy fatherly heart in true faith and bring forth much fruit in patience. Strengthen all the fainthearted and weak in faith.

F.12 The persecuted

Prayer. Uphold with thy mighty hand all that for thy name's and for righteousness' sake suffer imprisonment and persecution under the cruel Turk or otherwise.

F.13 The erring & unbelievers

Prayer. Show and lead all that err into the way of Christian truth and of eternal life. Enlighten all the blinded. Soften all the hardened. Bring back all that are fallen away from the Christian faith and the unity of thy Church. Drive out unbelief from the hearts of all men, that thy kingdom may daily come more and more, and thine only-begotten Son, our dear Lord and Saviour Jesus Christ, be known to the whole world and be lauded and praised of it.

F.14 Against the Turk

Rubric. Against the Turk and the persecutors of the Gospel

Bid. Include also therewith the horrible hereditary enemy of the Christian name, the Turk; praying that almighty God would smite him with the breath of his Holy Spirit, that the name of Jesus Christ be not blasphemed by him, nor so much Christian blood shed by him. For this and all other need of the whole of Christendom, and also for ourselves and for all for whom we are bound to pray, we will pray to God with hearty humility, not with the mouth only but with the whole heart, and say thus: Our Father, etc.

F.15 Against the Turk

Rubric. Or thus:

Prayer. Wilt thou also, O faithful God and Father, with thine almighty power withstand the might of the tyrannous, antichristian kingdom of the Turk, which setteth itself wantonly against Christ, together with all idolatry, tyranny and ungodly being, and cast it down to be the footstool of Christ's feet; that thy divine name, together with the faith of Christ in us, be not mocked and reviled by the unbelieving people and the enemies of the truth, but be enlarged and spread abroad by thy Holy Spirit, and the enemy be driven back through Christ Jesus.

F.16 Lord's Prayer

Rubric. The Our Father followeth:

Bid. In his name, O faithful, gracious and merciful Father, and at his bidding, we come before thy face and call upon thee, as our Lord Jesus Christ himself hath taught and commanded us to pray, and say:

Prayer. Our Father, which art in the heavens. Hallowed be thy name. Thy kingdom come. Thy will be done in earth, as it is in heaven. Give us this day our daily bread, and forgive us our debts, as we forgive our debtors; and lead us not into temptation, but deliver us from evil: for thine is the kingdom, and the power, and the glory, for ever. Amen.

6.11 Family G: Hessian Vermanung zum Gebet

Hessian "Vermanung zum Gebet" (Exhortation to prayer): a numbered bidding exhortation which the order allows to be shortened or lengthened locally.

- **Earliest witness (archetype):** Hessen 1566.
- **Tradition:** Moderate Reformed (Philip of Hesse's church).
- **Language:** German.
- **Form:** numbered bidding exhortation.
- **Place in the service (Hessen 1566):** The fifth part of the service: after the Creed and the sermon, "the prayer for all manner of estates and all manner of pressing need of the church", justified from Justin Martyr (Apol. I 65) and Tertullian (Apol. 30–39).

Year	Witness	Territory	Sehling	Form
1566	Hessen, Kirchenordnung 1566 (Moderate Reformed)	Landgraviate of Hesse	Sehling 8, I/Hessen Nr. 17 (KO 1566), pp. 245–246	bidding exhortation (numbered)

Sequence: G.1 Exhortation / preface > G.2 Ministers of the Word > G.3 Civil authority > G.4 The erring & unbelievers > G.5 Enemies > G.6 The afflicted > G.7 Deliverance from calamities > G.8 Conclusion > G.9 Special intercessions.

G.1 Exhortation / preface

Rubric. But the minister of the word may exhort the whole church to prayer on this wise: (in the margin: Exhortation to prayer)

Bid. Dearly beloved in the Lord, there is no man but knoweth and understandeth, so soon as he asketh his own conscience, that he needeth the help, benefits, grace and mercy of God at all times and in all places; for we are all of us poor, weak and frail men. But we are taught of the Lord Christ that we should ask and look for all good, yea, whatsoever is profitable and needful for us, from our heavenly Father alone, who ever knoweth what we need, with an humble and penitent heart out of true faith. Moreover, if we will witness that there is in us a spark of brotherly and unfeigned love, we are bound by the commandment and example of Christ to pray for others also, and not only for them that wish us well and do us good, but also for all estates of men, yea, also for our enemies and persecutors, and for whatsoever need besides. And how we should make our prayer unto God in common, all the God-fearing are instructed by the Spirit of God. Over and above all this we have a commandment from Christ that we should steadfastly ask in his name of his heavenly Father, who is, and will be known of all men as a gracious Lord and true almighty God and Father, who easily can and also will graciously give us all that is profitable and wholesome. Our Lord Christ hath also promised us that whatsoever we shall ask the heavenly Father in his name, he will give it us willingly and richly. Lastly, we know also from the promise of Christ that the prayer of every believer, to say nothing of the whole congregation lawfully gathered in the name of Christ, shall be heard for Christ's sake. Whence it followeth undeniably that the common prayer is a special mark and exercise of the Christian Church and of all believers, which is well-pleasing and acceptable unto almighty God. Therefore we also in this our assembly, with one mind in the Spirit and in truth, call upon God the Lord not only for ourselves but also for the whole Church and all estates and necessities of men:

G.2 Ministers of the Word

Bid. First and before all things for all ministers of God's word and for the happy course of the Gospel, that the same may be planted and spread abroad in all lands, and so the number of the believers in Christ may grow and increase, as we have commandment thereof from Christ and the Apostle Paul: namely, that utterance may be given unto the preachers to proclaim the word with the joyful opening of their mouth, that the mystery of the Gospel of Christ may be made known and manifest, and that they may deal and speak boldly therein, as it becometh, to the furtherance and joy of the faith of the congregation; and that unto the Church and congregation the grace in the Holy Ghost may be given in Christ, that she may be enriched in all doctrine and all knowledge, as the preaching of Christ becometh mighty in her, so that she come behind in no gift, and walk unblameably and worthily of the Gospel of Christ, and so stand fast in one spirit and in one soul, striving for the faith of the Gospel, and be in nothing terrified by the adversaries, but hold fast to the Gospel unto the end and wait for the revelation of Jesus Christ.

G.3 Civil authority

Bid. Secondly, we will also pray for the Emperor, kings, princes, magistrates and all in authority, and for a quiet government and common peace, as is commanded us by the Apostle in Timothy 2.

G.4 The erring & unbelievers

Bid. Thirdly, for all them that long for the knowledge of the truth, be they who they will; and also them that in foreign lands are persecuted and martyred for the truth's sake.

G.5 Enemies

Bid. Fourthly, we will also pray for all our adversaries and persecutors, but chiefly for them that out of ignorance resist the truth and persecute the Christians unjustly, that God the Lord would graciously forgive them this and not impute this grievous sin unto them, and that he would lead such to the knowledge of the truth, that they also may be saved.

G.6 The afflicted

Bid. Fifthly, for all the sick and them that have an inward or outward temptation, and also for all that are sorrowful by reason of the cross which God sendeth them, that they may be comforted, as we read in the Epistle of James, chapter 5.

G.7 Deliverance from calamities

Bid. Sixthly, we will also call upon God especially for the present common necessity. This petition is needful when war, hunger or dearth, or else other need and mishaps are at hand.

G.8 Conclusion

Bid. Seventhly, let us also pray for all that concerneth the whole Christian congregation, for all for which God will be called upon. We will also pray one for another, for ourselves that are here come together. And let us first forgive one another, and thereafter call upon God and pray for grace and forgiveness of sins.

G.9 Special intercessions

Rubric. This form of prayer may be made shorter or longer, according to the circumstances of each church.

6.12 Family H: Bugenhagen pulpit exhortation

Bugenhagen's pulpit exhortation after the sermon in Low German: the people are led through Creed, confession, biddings for all estates and needs, and the Our Father. Hamburg copies it verbatim; Osnabrück prescribes the same contents in indirect speech.

- **Earliest witness (archetype):** Braunschweig 1528 (Bugenhagen).
- **Tradition:** Lutheran.
- **Language:** Low German.
- **Form:** pulpit exhortation: Creed, confession, biddings, Our Father.
- **Place in the service (Braunschweig 1528):** From the pulpit after the sermon ("exhortation or admonition from the pulpit after the sermon"); the exhortation to communicants before the altar follows.

Year	Witness	Territory	Sehling	Form
1528	Braunschweig, Der erbarn stadt Brunswig christlike ordeninge (Bugenhagen)	Braunschweig (city)	Sehling 6/1, I/1, p. 443	exhortation: Creed + confession + biddings + Lord's Prayer
1529	Hamburg, Kirchenordnung (Bugenhagen)	Hamburg (city)	Sehling 5, Hamburg mit Landgebiet, pp. 530–531	exhortation: Creed + confession + biddings + Lord's Prayer
1543	Stift Osnabrück, Kirchenordnung (Hermann Bonnus): Ordenunge der evangelischen missen	Prince-Bishopric (Stift) and city of Osnabrück	Sehling 7/1, III/Stift Osnabrück, pp. 224–225	prescription of contents (indirect speech)

Osnabrück 1543 prescribes the contents in indirect speech. It supplies H.3 and H.5.

Not in the representative text (a minority reading of its category; see the Prayers sheet or the critical sheets): Osnabrück 1543 no. 2 (Civil authority).

Sequence: H.1 Creed > H.2 Confession of sins > H.3 The Word & its fruit > H.4 Civil authority > H.5 The present congregation > H.6 Ministers of the Word > H.7 Peace > H.8 Lord's Prayer > H.9 Special intercessions.

H.1 Creed

Witnesses: Braunschweig 1528 and Hamburg 1529.

Rubric. Exhortation or admonition from the pulpit after the sermon:

Bid. Dear friends in Christ, say with me the Creed. I believe in God the Father Almighty, etc.

H.2 Confession of sins

Witnesses: Braunschweig 1528 and Hamburg 1529.

Bid. Say also the confession with me, and confess your sins unto God, that God may be gracious unto us.

Prayer. God be merciful to me a poor sinner. I fail in faith, in that I love not God my Lord with my whole heart, nor trust wholly in him in temptations and in all need of body and soul. I ought to fear God alone and have him before mine eyes in all things; but now I fear the people that can do me evil for righteousness' sake. I fear to lose my goods, honour, friendship and life. I care for my living in unchristian wise, and seek in all things mine own, and not the things that are God's. Neither do I set my salvation wholly in Jesus Christ, his only-begotten Son, given for us. I fail also in love, in that I love not my neighbour as myself, but deal against him with evil suspicions, with backbiting, with words, with works, and can bear no word from him against me. I keep silence then the more, and cannot forgive him from the heart, and yet am bound to do so. Especially I have a burdened conscience in this temptation: N., in this sin: N. (Let every one bewail unto God his secret, grievous sin, unto amendment.) Therefore, almighty God, dear Father, forgive me all my sins, and enlighten my heart with thy truth, that I may hold thee for my gracious Father, and my neighbour for my brother, without all offence, according to thy word; through our Lord Jesus Christ. (Say:) Amen. Jesus Christ is our salvation for ever. (Say:) Amen.

H.3 The Word & its fruit

Witnesses: Osnabrück 1543.

Bid. After the exposition of the Gospel the pastor shall say over the words of the catechism for the sake of the common people, and thereafter exhort them to pray: first, for the cause of the holy Gospel;

H.4 Civil authority

Witnesses: Braunschweig 1528 and Hamburg 1529.

Bid. Let us now pray diligently for the Imperial Majesty, for kings, for lords, princes, princes' counsellors and town councillors, noblemen, burgomasters and judges, and all to whom the temporal sword is committed, especially for our prince of the land and for the council of this city, that God may be always with them with his grace, and grant them that they may rule unblameably in the temporal things that are committed unto them, that we under them may lead a quiet and still life in all godliness and honesty.

H.5 The present congregation

Witnesses: Osnabrück 1543.

Bid. thirdly, for the whole congregation and for all other need of body and soul, wherefor it is desired and is known to God. Thereafter shall be sung: Grant us peace graciously.

H.6 Ministers of the Word

Witnesses: Braunschweig 1528 and Hamburg 1529.

Bid. Pray ye also for the priests that feed us poor sheep with the word and Gospel of Christ, that they may set forth unto us the pure word of God with a steadfast heart to our amendment, and be kept from all error and strengthened unto all good against the devil and all gainsayers, that the Gospel of Christ may ever remain pure among us.

H.7 Peace

Witnesses: Braunschweig 1528 and Hamburg 1529.

Bid. Pray ye also for temporal peace; for the sick, the weak, the wretched and tempted folk; for women with child; for our enemies; for all need of body and soul. Amen. Let us pray one for another, that we may all be saved. Amen.

H.8 Lord's Prayer

Witnesses: Braunschweig 1528 and Hamburg 1529.

Bid. Say an Our Father, etc.

H.9 Special intercessions

Witnesses: Braunschweig 1528 and Hamburg 1529.

Rubric. If any special common needs befall, as to pray for the corn, hops, fruits, for seasonable weather, against evil murrain and pestilence, etc., that may well be brought in therewith.

6.13 Family I: Huberinus Vorbitt (Lord’s-Prayer order)

Caspar Huberinus' "Vorbitt" (intercession), whose first part is arranged by the petitions of the Lord's Prayer.

- **Earliest witness (archetype):** Öhringen 1544 (Huberinus).
- **Tradition:** Lutheran.
- **Language:** German.
- **Form:** bidding exhortation + Our Father.
- **Place in the service (Öhringen 1544):** After the sermon; closes with the Our Father, a declaration that the prayer is heard, and a reminder of the alms.

Year	Witness	Territory	Sehling	Form
1544	Öhringen (Hohenlohe), Vermahnungen und Gebete für den Gottesdienst (Caspar Huberinus)	County of Hohenlohe (Öhringen)	Sehling 15, Nr. 3 (Vermahnungen und Gebete 1544–1550), pp. 39–40	bidding exhortation + Lord’s Prayer

Sequence: I.1 Exhortation / preface > I.2 Civil authority > I.3 The persecuted > I.4 Peace > I.5 Repentance & forgiveness > I.6 Women with child > I.7 Special intercessions > I.8 Lord's Prayer > I.9 Conclusion.

I.1 Exhortation / preface

Rubric. A short exhortation and intercession, to pray for the Christian estates

Bid. Forasmuch as we are now here gathered together according to God’s commandment, to hear his wholesome word and thereafter also to make our prayer unto God the Lord in the name of Christ for all manner of pressing need of the whole of Christendom, we will call upon God the Almighty, our heavenly Father, out of childlike confidence with believing hearts, and pray him that he would graciously hear and grant us, for the sake of his divine truth and promise which hath been made us by his dear Son: that God the Lord would first and chiefly, out of fatherly faithfulness, impart, vouchsafe, defend and preserve unto us his holy word, the gracious Gospel, that we may preach, hear and obey the same purely and clearly with right understanding, that thereby his name may be hallowed and praised among us and in all the world. That God the Lord would also root out all false doctrine, error and heresy, and graciously keep us therefrom, that his kingdom may come to us and rule us with his word, grace and Holy Spirit, whereby the kingdom of Satan, of Mahomet and of Antichrist may come to an end and be laid waste and destroyed; that so his fatherly will may be done, not the will of the flesh, the world and Satan, but his will be done here among us on earth as above in heaven. Moreover, that God Almighty would everywhere ordain, preserve, defend and guard all faithful bishops, pastors, preachers and ministers of the Church.

I.2 Civil authority

Bid. We will also pray for the Christian magistrates, for the Imperial and Royal Majesty, for all Electors, princes, lords and all the estates of the Empire. But especially let us pray for our protecting lords and potentates, and likewise for their counsellors, officers and servants. God the Lord give them all together the true fear of God, wisdom and understanding to rule blessedly and well, that under their government we may yet longer have God’s word, temporal peace and sustenance.

I.3 The persecuted

Bid. We will also call upon God especially further and pray him for worthy Christendom, which everywhere is oppressed, afflicted and persecuted by the unbelievers, the Turk, Mahometan, antichristian, bloodthirsty people: that God would graciously defend and deliver the poor Christians and keep them in the right faith.

I.4 Peace

Bid. Let us also pray for all Christian subjects, that God the Lord would graciously keep them in due duty and obedience and guard them from discord and uproar, and so defend and preserve us all in fatherly wise from war, bloodshed, dearth, sickness, pestilence, hail, storm, hurtful tempest, from all vermin, poisoned air and the like, that we may receive our daily bread in all stillness, peace, rest and health.

I.5 Repentance & forgiveness

Bid. Let us also pray that God the Lord would graciously forgive us our debt, spare our frail life, not impute the old and former sins, but forgive them of grace in Christ our Lord; that he would also give us such an heart that we can forgive from the right ground them that grudge against us and our enemies, that we may have a loving heart toward our neighbour. That God the Lord would also not lead us into temptation nor let us fall into trial, but keep us of grace, that we fall not into the hurtful temptation and enticement of the flesh, the world and Satan; but that God Almighty would deliver us from evil, from all harm of body and soul, temporal and eternal.

I.6 Women with child

Bid. In especial let us pray for all women with child and in travail, for widows and orphans, for the dear youth, for married folk, especially where the evil enemy hath sown his seed, discord, bitterness and disunity; that neighbours also may show themselves one toward another united, peaceable, well-willing, serviceable and loving.

I.7 Special intercessions

Bid. Pray ye in conclusion for certain sick, tempted, fainthearted and comfortless persons, which commend themselves faithfully in especial to your Christian prayer. Pray ye also for them for whom we are especially bound to pray, which are commended to us in our office and prayer.

I.8 Lord's Prayer

Bid. For this and all other need of the whole of Christendom, and also for ourselves and ours, we will call upon God the Lord from the heart. Therefore make your prayer to God Almighty in the name of our Lord with your whole heart, and pray with devotion, inwardly, from the heart, an Our Father.

I.9 Conclusion

Rubric. After the prayer, the conclusion:

Prayer. Almighty God hath graciously heard our prayer according to his divine promise, in Christ our Lord. To him be laud, honour, glory and praise, now and for ever. Amen. Let the poor and needy be faithfully commended to you in your almsgiving.

6.14 Family J: Lower Saxon notel (Lüneburg/Wolfenbüttel)

Lower Saxon exhortation to prayer read "from the notel" after the sermon; passed verbatim to Braunschweig-Wolfenbüttel 1569 and Oldenburg 1573.

- **Earliest witness (archetype):** Lüneburg 1564.
- **Tradition:** Lutheran.
- **Language:** German.
- **Form:** bidding exhortation + Our Father.
- **Place in the service (Lüneburg 1564):** At the end of the sermon (never between the Gospel reading and its exposition, except for a woman in childbirth or one in peril of death); the communicants then come into the choir and kneel.

Year	Witness	Territory	Sehling	Form
1564	Braunschweig-Lüneburg (Celle), Kirchenordnung 1564	Duchy of Braunschweig-Lüneburg (Lüneburg)	Sehling 6/1, II/4, pp. 545–546	bidding exhortation + Lord’s Prayer
1569	Braunschweig-Wolfenbüttel, Kirchenordnung (Herzog Julius; Chemnitz/Andreae)	Duchy of Braunschweig-Wolfenbüttel	Sehling 6/1, I/3, pp. 145–146	bidding exhortation + Lord’s Prayer
1573	Oldenburg, Kirchenordnung 1573 (Graf Anton I.)	County of Oldenburg	Sehling 7/2, VI/Oldenburg Nr. 26 (KO 1573), pp. 1146–1147	bidding exhortation + Lord’s Prayer

The magistrates are prayed for twice: for the Emperor and all magistrates (J.2), and, after a thanksgiving for the princes of the land, for the princess and the young lordship (J.4).

Sequence: J.1 The Word & its fruit > J.2 Civil authority > J.3 Thanksgiving > J.4 Civil authority > J.5 The afflicted > J.6 Deliverance from calamities > J.7 Lord's Prayer > J.8 Special intercessions.

J.1 The Word & its fruit

Witnesses: Lüneburg 1564, Braunschweig-Wolfenbüttel 1569 and Oldenburg 1573.

Rubric. Thereupon the people shall again be exhorted to prayer and thanksgiving toward God, and all together for the preservation of the Church of God and of right doctrine, and moreover of the faithful, true teachers, and that God would send faithful labourers into his harvest; for the magistrates, for temporal peace and the growth of the fruits; and in sum for the need of the whole of Christendom and of particular persons that desire the Christian prayer; whereof a draft followeth, after this manner.

Bid. Dear Christians, let us pray God that he would graciously keep us in his divine word, and send faithful labourers into his harvest; vouchsafe his Holy Spirit unto the preachers and ministers of the Church, that they may set forth and teach the same purely and rightly, and also go before with godly life; and that the Almighty would graciously keep them and us from false doctrine, and restrain and withstand the same. That he would also graciously help our brethren and sisters which are assailed and oppressed with false doctrine or else with unrighteous violence by unchristian men or other tyrants, that they may abide steadfast in true faith and patience, and, if it be possible, that the persecution may be taken from them or mitigated.

J.2 Civil authority

Witnesses: Lüneburg 1564, Braunschweig-Wolfenbüttel 1569 and Oldenburg 1573.

Bid. Pray ye also for the temporal magistrates, the Imperial Majesty and other potentates, and all others that sit in the office of magistracy: that the Almighty would graciously keep therein them that are enlightened by God’s word, but give his grace unto them that are not yet enlightened, that they may suffer and receive God’s word in their lands; but that he would restrain them that will not do so and persecute it, and bring their purpose to shame.

J.3 Thanksgiving

Witnesses: Lüneburg 1564, Braunschweig-Wolfenbüttel 1569 and Oldenburg 1573.

Bid. Especially give thanks to God that he hath so graced our gracious princes and lords of the land that they love God’s word and let it be preached and further it in their land; and pray that the Almighty would graciously keep them therein and vouchsafe him godly long life, health and grace, that they may so lead their government that it may redound to the honour of God and to the good of their princely Graces and their subjects, and that we may lead a quiet, peaceable life under them in all godliness.

J.4 Civil authority

Witnesses: Lüneburg 1564, Braunschweig-Wolfenbüttel 1569 and Oldenburg 1573.

Bid. Pray ye also for our gracious princess of the land, that the Almighty would have her also in his gracious protection, guard her from all mischief, and bless her in body and soul. Pray ye also for the counsellors, officers and governors, and also the council of this town, that God would give them grace to counsel well and faithfully to preside over and perform the offices and charges committed unto them.

J.5 The afflicted

Witnesses: Lüneburg 1564, Braunschweig-Wolfenbüttel 1569 and Oldenburg 1573.

Bid. Pray ye also for all tempted and sorrowful hearts, for all the sick, women with child, young children, and all that are in need, that the Almighty would comfort and guard them all, and stand by them and come to their help in their needs.

J.6 Deliverance from calamities

Witnesses: Lüneburg 1564, Braunschweig-Wolfenbüttel 1569 and Oldenburg 1573.

Bid. Pray ye for us all in this congregation and in the whole land, that God would be gracious unto us and keep us from war, pestilence and dearth, from fire and flood, from hail and tempest, and from all mischance and evil; and that he would guard the fruits upon the field and give blessing and grace, that we may enjoy them with peace, health and thanksgiving.

J.7 Lord's Prayer

Witnesses: Lüneburg 1564, Braunschweig-Wolfenbüttel 1569 and Oldenburg 1573.

Bid. Let every one lay his own need before God, and pray ye in the name of Christ upon his promise, where he saith: Whatsoever ye ask in my name, believe, and ye shall have it; and say from the ground of the heart: Our Father, etc.

J.8 Special intercessions

Witnesses: Lüneburg 1564, Braunschweig-Wolfenbüttel 1569 and Oldenburg 1573.

Rubric. If then aught befall whereof special petition is to be made, as for particular sick persons, for women that are in the pains of childbirth, and whatsoever else of need and matters of the land or of particular persons may befall, that shall be added to this common prayer also in short words.

6.15 Family K: Three collects from the pulpit

After an exhortation the minister reads three collects from the pulpit: thanksgiving or the Church, the magistrates, and a special need, chosen from a bank.

- **Earliest witness (archetype):** Worms 1560.
- **Tradition:** Lutheran.
- **Language:** German.
- **Form:** exhortation + three collects.
- **Place in the service (Worms 1560):** On Sundays and feasts, when the choir has finished the first psalm or hymn, the minister goes into the pulpit, exhorts the people to prayer and reads three collects: (1) a thanksgiving for God’s gifts or a prayer for the preservation of the Church and God’s word (on feasts, a thanksgiving for the feast), (2) for the magistrates, (3) a special prayer as the time requires (peace, protection, fruits of the earth, rain …).

Year	Witness	Territory	Sehling	Form
1560	Worms, Agendbüchlein 1560	Worms (Imperial city)	Sehling 19, III/4, pp. 178–183	exhortation + three collects

Worms reads three collects from the pulpit: a thanksgiving, or a prayer for the Church and God's word; one for the magistrates; and a third that varies with the time, chosen from the collect bank that follows in the order. K.2 and K.3 are the two texts for the first collect, K.4 is the collect for the magistrates, and K.5 is the rubric for the third.

Sequence: K.1 Exhortation / preface > K.2 Thanksgiving > K.3 The Church > K.4 Civil authority > K.5 Special intercessions.

K.1 Exhortation / preface

Rubric. VI. Of the common prayer. Although at the end of all sermons the people are sufficiently exhorted to pray earnestly and diligently for all the need and concerns of the whole of Christendom in the spiritual, temporal and household government, and also to thankfulness toward God for his great and manifold benefits, yet for the sake of greater remembrance certain other common prayers and collects are also held and read plainly to the people in the following order. On Sundays and feast days, when the choir hath finished the first psalm or spiritual song, the minister goeth into the pulpit and exhorteth the people to prayer, and readeth to them three collects at a time. The first is either a common thanksgiving for all manner of God's gifts, or a prayer for the preservation of the Church and God's word, or, if it be on special feasts, a thanksgiving for those special gifts whereof it is wont to be treated on that feast. The second is of the temporal magistrates. The third is special, according to the occasion of the time: either for peace, or for protection, or for the fruits of the earth, or for rain, etc., and whatsoever like special need and concern may befall, whereof the Christian Church must be put in mind, out of the register following.

K.2 Thanksgiving

Rubric. A common thanksgiving for all manner of benefits of God.

Prayer. Almighty Lord God, heavenly Father, of whom we without ceasing receive all manner of good right abundantly, and are daily kept from all evil stately and graciously: we beseech thee, give us by thy Spirit to acknowledge all this with our whole heart in right faith, that we may thank thy bountiful goodness and mercy here and there eternally, and praise thee; through our Lord Jesus Christ thy dear Son, etc.

K.3 The Church

Rubric. For the preservation and fruitful increase of God's word.

Prayer. Almighty God, we beseech thee, give unto thy congregation thy Spirit and divine wisdom, that thy word may run and grow among us and be preached with all boldness, as it becometh, and that thy holy Christian congregation may be bettered thereby; that we may serve thee with steadfast faith and continue in the confession of thy name unto the end; through our Lord, etc.

K.4 Civil authority

Rubric. For the temporal magistrates alone.

Prayer. O merciful heavenly Father, in whose hand standeth all power of men and the welfare of the godly, in whose hand also stand all the rights and laws of all realms upon earth: we beseech thee, look graciously upon thy servants, the Roman Emperor, all kings, princes and Christian magistrates, that they may bear the temporal sword, committed unto them of thee, according to thy commandment. Enlighten them and keep them in thy divine name; give them, dear Lord, wisdom and understanding and a peaceable government, that they may defend and rule their subjects in peace, rest and unity. Prolong their days, O God of our salvation, that under their dominion we together with them may hallow and praise thy divine name; through our Lord Jesus Christ, etc.

K.5 Special intercessions

Rubric. The third is special … out of the register following.

6.16 Family L: Intercessions under the Sanctus (Brandenburg 1540)

Not a pulpit prayer but collects said by the priest in the Mass under the Sanctus, for ministers, magistrates and peace, in the place the Roman Canon had its intercessions. Followed by Calenberg-Göttingen 1542 and Pfalz-Neuburg 1543.

- **Earliest witness (archetype):** Brandenburg 1540.
- **Tradition:** Lutheran.
- **Language:** German.
- **Form:** collects said by the priest under the Sanctus.

- **Place in the service (Brandenburg 1540):** In the Mass, after the Preface, while the Latin Sanctus is sung; followed by the Verba (sung in German, with elevation) and the Our Father. The prayers stand where the Roman Canon had its intercessions.

Year	Witness	Territory	Sehling	Form
1540	Mark Brandenburg, Kirchenordnung (Kurfürst Joachim II.)	Electorate of Brandenburg	Sehling 3, Mark Brandenburg Nr. 3, pp. 68–69	collects said by the priest
1542	Calenberg-Göttingen, Kirchenordnung (Herzogin Elisabeth; Corvinus)	Principality of Calenberg-Göttingen	Sehling 6/2, III/Calenberg-Göttingen, p. 815	collect said by the priest
1543	Pfalz-Neuburg, Kirchenordnung (Pfalzgraf Ottheinrich; Osiander)	Palatinate-Neuburg	Sehling 13, I.2, p. 74	collects said by the priest

Each collect ends "through thy Son Jesus Christ. Amen." in place of the abbreviation "through our Lord etc." (Introduction, Representative texts, rule 4).

Sequence: L.1 Civil authority > L.2 Ministers of the Word > L.3 Peace > L.4 Repentance & forgiveness > L.5 Lord's Prayer.

L.1 Civil authority

Witnesses: Brandenburg 1540, Calenberg-Göttingen 1542 and Pfalz-Neuburg 1543.

Rubric. Under the Sanctus the priest shall pray the following prayer in German. ¶ For the magistrates.

Prayer. Merciful heavenly Father, in whose hands standeth all power and authority of men, ordained of thee for the punishment of evildoers and the protection of the godly, in whose hands also stand all the rights and laws of all lands: we beseech thee, be gracious unto our lord the Emperor, all kings and princes, especially unto our prince and lord of the land N., and unto the council and rulers of this city and all lawful magistrates, that they may rightly bear the temporal sword which thou hast committed unto them. Overshadow them with the power of the Highest; enlighten them and keep them in thy divine name; let them love thy divine word from the heart and hold fast thereto, and in no wise suffer it to be persecuted. Give them, dear Lord, wisdom and understanding and a peaceable government, that they may rule and defend all their subjects in the truth and righteousness that is well-pleasing unto thee. Also, my dear God, prolong their life according to thy will; and forasmuch as the judgement is thine and they sit in thy stead, give them grace so to rule that thy holy name may be hallowed and praised through them, from henceforth even for ever. This help them the Lord Jesus Christ, thy beloved Son. Amen.

L.2 Ministers of the Word

Witnesses: Brandenburg 1540 and Pfalz-Neuburg 1543.

Rubric. Another.

Prayer. O almighty, gracious God and Father of our Lord Jesus Christ, who hast earnestly commanded us that we should pray thee for labourers into thine harvest, that is, for right and true preachers of thy word: we beseech thy bottomless mercy that thou wouldest send us right and true teachers and ministers of thy divine word, and give thy wholesome word into their heart and into their mouth, that they may faithfully perform thy commandment and preach nothing that is contrary to thy holy word; to the end that we, being by thy heavenly, eternal word admonished, taught, fed, comforted and strengthened, may do that which is well-pleasing unto thee and profitable unto us. Give, O Lord, unto thy holy Christian Church thy Spirit and divine wisdom, that thy word may run and grow among us and be preached with all boldness, as it becometh, and that thy holy Christian congregation may be bettered thereby; that we may serve thee with steadfast faith and continue in the knowledge of thy name unto the end; through thy Son Jesus Christ. Amen.

L.3 Peace

Witnesses: Brandenburg 1540 and Pfalz-Neuburg 1543.

Rubric. Another.

Prayer. Almighty God and everlasting Father, a King of glory and a Lord of heaven and of earth, by whose Spirit all things are governed, by whose providence all things are ordered; thou art a God of peace, from whom alone unity cometh unto us: we beseech thee through our Lord Jesus Christ that thou wouldest forgive us our sins and endue us with thy divine peace and unity, that we may serve thy name in fear and trembling, and that thou mayest be praised of us evermore. Amen.

L.4 Repentance & forgiveness

Witnesses: Brandenburg 1540.

Prayer. Merciful God and heavenly Father, whose mercy hath no end, who art longsuffering, gracious and of great goodness and faithfulness, and forgivest all iniquity, transgression and sin: we have, alas, sinned with our fathers, we have done amiss and dealt wickedly and oftentimes provoked thee to wrath; against thee only have we sinned and done evil in thy sight. But, Lord, remember not against us our former iniquities; let thy mercy speedily be great upon us, for we are brought very low. Help us, O God of our salvation, for the glory of thy name; deliver us and forgive us our sins; through thy Son Jesus Christ. Amen.

L.5 Lord's Prayer

Witnesses: Brandenburg 1540, Calenberg-Göttingen 1542 and Pfalz-Neuburg 1543. *Calenberg-Göttingen 1542 lacks the rubric.*

Rubric. Thereupon the Pater noster shall be sung in German, as followeth.

Bid. Let us pray, as the Lord Christ Jesus hath commanded us, that out of right confidence and trust we may be bold to say:

Prayer. Our Father, which art in heaven, hallowed be thy name, thy kingdom come, thy will be done, as in heaven, so in earth; give us this day our daily bread, and forgive us our debts, as we forgive our debtors; and lead us not into temptation, but deliver us from evil: for thine is the kingdom, and the power, and the glory, for ever.

6.17 Family M: Pulpit biddings in the Prone pattern

Early East Frisian pulpit biddings after the medieval Prone: three biddings, then Decalogue, confession, Creed and Our Father.

- **Earliest witness (archetype):** Norden 1528.
- **Tradition:** Reformed (an early East Frisian evangelical order, printed by Sehling among the Reformed orders of East Frisia).
- **Language:** Low Dutch.
- **Form:** biddings, then Decalogue, confession, Creed, Our Father.
- **Place in the service (Norden 1528):** Every Sunday after the sermon : three biddings, then the Ten Commandments, a confession of sins, the Creed with a confession of faith, and the Our Father.

Year	Witness	Territory	Sehling	Form
1528	Norden (East Frisia), Gottesdienstordnung [ca. 1528] (Reformed)	Norden, County of East Frisia	Sehling 7/1, IV/Ostfriesland Nr. 6, p. 431	biddings + Decalogue + confession + Creed + Lord’s Prayer

Sequence: M.1 Civil authority > M.2 Ministers of the Word > M.3 Enemies > M.4 Ten Commandments.

M.1 Civil authority

Rubric. This manner written hereafter is observed at Norden every Sunday after the sermon.

Bid. I. Let us call upon and pray God, our heavenly Father, for our gracious lord with his council and officers, and for all the magistracy of the world, that God would govern them and let them govern according to his word and Spirit, unto the common welfare and peace.

M.2 Ministers of the Word

Bid. II. For all faithful ministers and shepherds of the sheep of Christ, that they may set forth God’s word boldly and with one accord, and preach Christ crucified.

M.3 Enemies

Bid. III. Item, for all our enemies and all unbelievers: heathen, Jews, Turks and false Christians, that God would enlighten them with his word and Spirit and give them good shepherds. Let us confess our weakness and sins, which are made manifest to us out of God's law and commandments.

M.4 Ten Commandments

Rubric. The Ten Commandments. … I believe in God the Father … Our Father in the heavens …

6.18 Family R1: Heidelberg 1563 prayer

The Reformed Sunday prayer after the sermon: confession and absolution, a long continuous prayer (fruit of the Word, ministers, magistrates, all men, the persecuted, the afflicted, the congregation), then the Our Father. Copied in Moers, Bentheim-Tecklenburg, Ysenburg-Birstein 1598 and, abridged, Lutheran Schaumburg 1614.

- **Earliest witness (archetype):** Kurpfalz 1563 (Heidelberg).
- **Tradition:** Reformed (Schaumburg 1614 Lutheran).
- **Language:** German.
- **Form:** confession + absolution + continuous prayer + Our Father.
- **Place in the service (Kurpfalz 1563):** Sunday morning after the sermon: exhortation to confession, confession, absolution (with retention), then the prayer and the Our Father; a psalm and the Aaronic blessing follow. The prayer before the sermon is a separate confession of sins.

Year	Witness	Territory	Sehling	Form
1563	Kurpfalz, Kirchenordnung (Friedrich III.) (Reformed)	Electoral Palatinate	Sehling 14, Regierungszeit Friedrichs III. Nr. 60 (KO 1563), pp. 389–390	confession + absolution + continuous prayer + Lord's Prayer
1581	Moers, Kirchenordnung [1581] (Graf Adolf von Neuenahr) (Reformed)	County of Moers	Sehling 22, III/Moers Nr. 5 (KO [1581]), pp. 182–183	continuous prayer + Lord's Prayer
1588	Bentheim-Tecklenburg, Kirchenordnung 1588/1619 (Reformed)	Counties of Bentheim, Tecklenburg and Steinfurt	Sehling 22, IV/3, pp. 256–257	continuous prayer + Lord's Prayer
1598	Ysenburg-Birstein, Kirchenordnung 1598 (Graf Wolfgang Ernst) (Reformed)	County of Ysenburg-Büdingen-Birstein	Sehling 10, III/Ysenburg-Birstein Nr. 17, pp. 664–666	confession + absolution + continuous prayer + Lord's Prayer
1614	Schaumburg, Kirchenordnung 1614 (Graf/Fürst Ernst) (Lutheran)	County of Holstein-Schaumburg	Sehling 7/2.2, I/21, pp. 147–149	confession + absolution + continuous prayer

Schaumburg 1614 is a Lutheran order that takes over the Heidelberg confession, absolution and prayer, abridged.

Not in the representative text (a minority reading of its category; see the Prayers sheet or the critical sheets): Schaumburg 1614 no. 7 (Fruits of the earth).

Sequence: R1.1 Confession of sins > R1.2 Confession of sins > R1.3 Thanksgiving > R1.4 The Word & its fruit > R1.5 Civil authority > R1.6 Fruits of the earth > R1.7 All men > R1.8 The persecuted > R1.9 The afflicted > R1.10 Lord's Prayer.

R1.1 Confession of sins

Witnesses: Kurpfalz 1563, Ysenburg-Birstein 1598 and Schaumburg 1614.

Rubric. On Sunday after the morning sermon the minister shall say:

Bid. Dearly beloved in the Lord, forasmuch as we see in the commandments of God as in a glass how great and manifold our sins are, whereby we deserve temporal and eternal punishment, let us confess the same from the heart unto our faithful Father; say therefore with me thus:

Prayer. I, poor sinner, confess before thee, my God and Creator, that I, alas, have sinned grievously and manifoldly against thee, not only with outward gross sins, but much more with inward, inborn blindness, unbelief, doubting, faintheartedness, impatience, pride, evil covetousness, secret envy, hatred and grudging, and other evil wiles, as thou, my Lord and God, knowest in me, and I, alas, cannot sufficiently know; they repent me and grieve me, and I desire grace from my heart, through thy dear Son Jesus Christ.

R1.2 Confession of sins

Witnesses: Kurpfalz 1563, Ysenburg-Birstein 1598 and Schaumburg 1614. *Schaumburg 1614 lacks the rubric.*

Rubric. Thereupon he shall declare unto the faithful the forgiveness of sins, and unto the impenitent the judgement of God, and say thus:

Prayer. Hear now the sure comfort of the grace of God, which he promiseth in his Gospel to all believers. Thus saith the Lord Christ in John the third: God so loved the world, that he gave his only begotten Son, that whosoever believeth in him should not perish, but have everlasting life. As many of you therefore as are displeased with yourselves and your sins, and trust that they are wholly and altogether forgiven them through the merit of Jesus Christ alone, and have the purpose more and more to cease from sins and to serve the Lord in true holiness and righteousness, unto them (forasmuch as they believe in the Son of the living God) I declare by the commandment of God that they are loosed in heaven from all their sins (as he promiseth in his holy Gospel) through the perfect satisfaction of the most holy suffering and death of our Lord Jesus Christ. Amen. But as many among you as yet have pleasure in their sins and shame, or continue in sins against their conscience, unto them I declare by the commandment of God that the wrath and judgement of God abideth upon them, and that all their sins are retained in heaven, and that they cannot be loosed from eternal damnation until they be converted.

R1.3 Thanksgiving

Witnesses: Kurpfalz 1563, Moers 1581, Bentheim-Tecklenburg 1588, Ysenburg-Birstein 1598 and Schaumburg 1614. *Ysenburg-Birstein 1598 lacks the rubric. Moers 1581 and Bentheim-Tecklenburg 1588 lack the bid.*

Rubric. Prayer on Sunday after the sermon and absolution.

Bid. Forasmuch now as we doubt not that we and our prayer are sanctified through the suffering of Jesus Christ and acceptable unto God, let us call upon him from the heart and say thus:

Prayer. Almighty God, Creator of heaven and of earth, we give thee thanks from the ground of our heart that thou hast created us, and unto this day hast preserved, fed and nourished us and our children, and wilt yet henceforth preserve and govern us. But especially we give thee thanks that thou hast given us to know thy Son Jesus Christ, whom thou didst promise in Paradise, and hast forgiven us our sins through his bitter suffering and death.

R1.4 The Word & its fruit

Witnesses: Kurpfalz 1563, Moers 1581, Bentheim-Tecklenburg 1588 and Ysenburg-Birstein 1598.

Prayer. And we beseech thee that thou wouldest renew us unto the image of thy Son Jesus Christ through the preaching of thy word and the power of thy Holy Spirit, that we may live with thee eternally in body and soul and praise thee, whereunto we were created in the beginning; and that thou wouldest withstand Satan, that he snatch not thy holy word out of our hearts, as he did to our first parents Adam and Eve.

R1.5 Civil authority

Witnesses: Kurpfalz 1563, Moers 1581, Bentheim-Tecklenburg 1588, Ysenburg-Birstein 1598 and Schaumburg 1614.

Prayer. And forasmuch as thou wilt govern us in this life also by the hand of our magistrates, thy ministers, we beseech thee, who hast their hearts in thy hand, that thou wouldest vouchsafe unto them all, the Imperial and royal Majesty, all princes and lords, especially our most gracious Elector and prince of this land, Duke Frederick, Count Palatine, together with his Electoral Grace's consort, the young lordship, counsellors and officers (and also an honourable council of this city, or an honourable commune of this place), grace and unity, that they may direct their whole government to this end, that our Lord Jesus Christ, unto whom thou hast given all power in heaven and in earth, may reign over them and their subjects; that the poor people, which are the creatures of thy hands and the sheep of thy pasture, for whom also the Lord Jesus hath shed his blood, may be governed in all holiness and righteousness; and that we also for thy sake may show them all due honour and faithfulness, and lead under them an honest, peaceable and Christian life.

R1.6 Fruits of the earth

Witnesses: Kurpfalz 1563, Moers 1581, Bentheim-Tecklenburg 1588 and Ysenburg-Birstein 1598.

Prayer. Give also thy blessing and benediction to the fruit of the earth, that we may thereby acknowledge thee as a Father and fountain of all mercy and good things.

R1.7 All men

Witnesses: Kurpfalz 1563, Moers 1581, Bentheim-Tecklenburg 1588, Ysenburg-Birstein 1598 and Schaumburg 1614.

Prayer. We pray thee also not for ourselves only, but also for all men of the whole world, that thou wouldest have mercy upon them all graciously;

R1.8 The persecuted

Witnesses: Kurpfalz 1563, Moers 1581, Bentheim-Tecklenburg 1588 and Ysenburg-Birstein 1598.

Prayer. but especially upon them that are our fellow members in the body of Jesus Christ and for thy truth's sake suffer persecution from the Turk and the Pope. Restrain, O Father of all grace, such raging of thine enemies, which persecute thy Son Jesus in his members, and strengthen the persecuted with invincible steadfastness and the power of thy Holy Spirit, that they may receive such persecution from thy hand with thanksgiving, and in their tribulation feel such joy as passeth all understanding.

R1.9 The afflicted

Witnesses: Kurpfalz 1563, Moers 1581, Bentheim-Tecklenburg 1588, Ysenburg-Birstein 1598 and Schaumburg 1614.

Prayer. Comfort and strengthen all the poor, the captives, the sick, widows and orphans, women with child, and troubled and tempted hearts, and give them thy peace;

R1.10 Lord's Prayer

Witnesses: Kurpfalz 1563, Moers 1581, Bentheim-Tecklenburg 1588 and Ysenburg-Birstein 1598.

Prayer. through our dear Lord Jesus Christ, who hath made us this sure promise: Verily, verily, I say unto you, Whatsoever ye shall ask the Father in my name, he will give it you; and hath commanded us thereupon to pray thus: Our Father, etc.

6.19 Family R2: Heidelberg Lord's-Prayer paraphrase

The Heidelberg alternative prayer paraphrasing the Lord's Prayer clause by clause (after Geneva and the Heidelberg Catechism qq. 122-127).

- **Earliest witness (archetype):** Kurpfalz 1563, alternative.
- **Tradition:** Reformed.
- **Language:** German.
- **Form:** Lord's Prayer paraphrase.

- **Place in the service (Kurpfalz 1563):** Alternative ("Or thus") to the Sunday prayer after the sermon (after confession and absolution); followed by the Our Father, a psalm and the blessing.

Year	Witness	Territory	Sehling	Form
1563	Kurpfalz, Kirchenordnung (Friedrich III.) (Reformed)	Electoral Palatinate	Sehling 14, Regierungszeit Friedrichs III. Nr. 60 (KO 1563), pp. 390–391	Lord's Prayer paraphrase
1588	Bentheim-Tecklenburg, Kirchenordnung 1588/1619 (Reformed)	Counties of Bentheim, Tecklenburg and Steinfurt	Sehling 22, IV/3, pp. 256–258	Lord's Prayer paraphrase + Creed

Each rubric is the clause of the Lord's Prayer that the paragraph expounds. Sehling prints the clauses in square brackets in Kurpfalz 1563. Bentheim-Tecklenburg 1588 adds R2.9.

Sequence: R2.1 Exhortation / preface > R2.2 The Word & its fruit > R2.3 The Church > R2.4 All estates / households > R2.5 Fruits of the earth > R2.6 Repentance & forgiveness > R2.7 The present congregation > R2.8 Conclusion > R2.9 Creed.

R2.1 Exhortation / preface

Witnesses: Kurpfalz 1563 and Bentheim-Tecklenburg 1588.

Rubric. Or thus:

Prayer. Almighty God, heavenly Father, who hast promised us that whatsoever we shall ask thee in the name of thy beloved Son Jesus Christ, thou wilt surely give it us:

R2.2 The Word & its fruit

Witnesses: Kurpfalz 1563 and Bentheim-Tecklenburg 1588. *The rubric is in Kurpfalz 1563 only.*

Rubric. Hallowed be thy name.

Prayer. We beseech thee that thou wouldest work in us by thy Holy Spirit, that we may rightly know thee, and hallow, extol and praise thee in all thy works, wherein shineth thine almightiness, wisdom, goodness, righteousness, mercy and truth; and that we also may so direct our whole life, thoughts, words and works, that thy name be not blasphemed for our sakes, but honoured and praised.

R2.3 The Church

Witnesses: Kurpfalz 1563 and Bentheim-Tecklenburg 1588. *The rubric is in Kurpfalz 1563 only.*

Rubric. Thy kingdom come.

Prayer. Rule us also so by the sceptre of thy word and the power of thy Holy Spirit, that we and all men may from day to day submit and yield ourselves more unto thy Majesty; preserve and increase thy Church, and destroy all the works of the devil and all false and wicked counsels devised against thy holy word. Confound thine enemies by the might of thy truth and righteousness, that so all power which exalteth itself against thine honour may from day to day be more destroyed and brought to nought, until the perfection of thy kingdom come, when thou shalt reveal thy glory in us at the last judgement and be all in all for ever.

R2.4 All estates / households

Witnesses: Kurpfalz 1563 and Bentheim-Tecklenburg 1588. *The rubric is in Kurpfalz 1563 only.*

Rubric. Thy will be done, etc.

Prayer. Grant also that we and all men may renounce our own will and all the lusts of our flesh, and obey thy will, which alone is good, without any gainsaying; that so every man may perform his office and calling as willingly and faithfully as the angels in

heaven.

R2.5 Fruits of the earth

Witnesses: Kurpfalz 1563 and Bentheim-Tecklenburg 1588. *The rubric is in Kurpfalz 1563 only.*

Rubric. Give us this day our daily bread.

Prayer. Provide us also with all bodily necessaries, and vouchsafe us peace and good government, that we may thereby acknowledge that thou art the only fountain of all good and a faithful Father who careth for his children, and that without thy blessing neither our care and labour nor thy gifts can prosper us; and that we may therefore withdraw our trust from all creatures and set it upon thee alone.

R2.6 Repentance & forgiveness

Witnesses: Kurpfalz 1563 and Bentheim-Tecklenburg 1588. *The rubric is in Kurpfalz 1563 only.*

Rubric. Forgive us our debts, etc.

Prayer. Impute not unto us poor sinners all our misdeeds and debts, nor the evil that yet always cleaveth unto us, for the sake of the shedding of the blood of Jesus Christ; even as we also find this witness of thy grace in our hearts, that we forgive our neighbour from the heart and desire to further his good.

R2.7 The present congregation

Witnesses: Kurpfalz 1563 and Bentheim-Tecklenburg 1588. *The rubric is in Kurpfalz 1563 only.*

Rubric. Lead us not into temptation, etc.

Prayer. And forasmuch as we of ourselves are so weak that we cannot stand one moment, and moreover our sworn enemies, the devil, the world and our own flesh, cease not to assail us: uphold and strengthen us by the power of thy Holy Spirit, that we may make firm resistance against them and not be overcome in this spiritual warfare, but abide steadfast, until at the last we obtain the victory perfectly and reign for ever in thy kingdom with thy Son, our Lord and protector Jesus Christ.

R2.8 Conclusion

Witnesses: Kurpfalz 1563 and Bentheim-Tecklenburg 1588.

Prayer. All which we ask of thee, that thereby not we but thou mayest be praised for ever; and that thou canst do this as an almighty God, and wilt do it as a faithful Father, as surely as we desire this of thee from the heart; through our Lord Jesus Christ. Amen. Our Father, etc.

R2.9 Creed

Witnesses: Bentheim-Tecklenburg 1588.

Prayer. Give us also steadfastness and daily increase in the old, true and undoubted Christian faith, that thereby we may make ourselves more and more partakers of Christ Jesus and all his benefits; of which faith we make confession with mouth and heart, saying: I believe in God the Father Almighty, etc.

6.20 Family R3: Calvin’s “grande prière” (Strasbourg/Geneva)

Calvin's Strasbourg/Geneva "grande prière" in Latin, for the French refugee church, ending in a paraphrase of the Lord's Prayer.

- **Earliest witness (archetype):** Frankfurt 1554 (Poullain).
- **Tradition:** Reformed.
- **Language:** Latin.
- **Form:** continuous prayer ending in a Lord's Prayer paraphrase.

- **Place in the service (Frankfurt 1554 (Poullain)):** Sunday morning: after the hour-long sermon and the announcements (betrothals, baptisms, the poor and sick who commend themselves to the prayers of the Church), while deacons collect alms at the door; followed immediately by the Creed, a psalm and the Aaronic blessing.

Year	Witness	Territory	Sehling	Form
1554	Frankfurt, Liturgia sacra of the stranger congregation (Valérand Poullain) (Reformed)	Frankfurt am Main: French/Walloon refugee church	Sehling 9, VI/Frankfurt Nr. 14, pp. 563–566	continuous prayer with Lord's-Prayer paraphrase

The words between asterisks in R3.8 are said only when the Supper is celebrated.

Sequence: R3.1 Special intercessions > R3.2 Exhortation / preface > R3.3 Civil authority > R3.4 Ministers of the Word > R3.5 All men > R3.6 The afflicted > R3.7 The persecuted > R3.8 The present congregation > R3.9 Lord's Prayer > R3.10 Creed.

R3.1 Special intercessions

Rubric. He endeth the sermon within the space of an hour and concludeth it with the prayer subjoined. But first he admonisheth the Church of aught that is worthy or needful: as, if there be betrothals, if a baptism, if any poor or sick man commend himself to the prayers of the Church, and other things of the kind. Meanwhile two deacons at the door ask alms of every one for the use of the poor.

R3.2 Exhortation / preface

Rubric. Prayer

Prayer. Almighty God, heavenly Father, thou hast promised to hear our petitions, in whatsoever thing we call upon thee in the name of thy beloved Son Jesus Christ our Lord. He also hath so taught us to hold holy assemblies among us in his name, inviting us moreover with bountiful promises, that he will be in the midst of these our assemblies, that by him our only Mediator and Intercessor we may obtain of thee whatsoever we shall ask with one accord upon earth. And first of all thou commandest us to pray for all whom thou hast willed to be in authority over us, and thereafter for those things that pertain to the needful uses of thy people and of all men. Obeying this thy commandment, and trusting only in thy most holy ordinance and thy promises, we are come together here before thee in the name of Christ thy Son our Lord, humbly beseeching thee from the heart, O God and most good Father, in the name of our only Deliverer and Mediator, that of thy clemency thou wouldest freely pardon us all our sins, and so bend and draw unto thee our hearts, minds, thoughts and all our desires, that we may be able to call upon thee with true and single prayer, which may be pleasing and acceptable unto thee.

R3.3 Civil authority

Prayer. We pray therefore thy clemency, O heavenly Father, for princes and all men bearing authority, thy servants, to whom it is committed of thee to do justice to thy people, and by name for the consuls and senate of this city: that thou wouldest vouchsafe to bestow upon them thy Spirit, which is truly a princely Spirit and the governor of wills, and increase more and more from day to day his gifts, power and grace; that they may truly acknowledge the one and only Christ thy Son our Lord, the King of kings, holding the principality above all power, to whom indeed all power in heaven and in earth hath been given of thee; and then, being persuaded with sure faith, may study with all their hearts to approve themselves unto him with true and spiritual worship, and to advance and enlarge his kingdom among their subjects, whom also they may rule according to the prescript of thy will out of thy law, as they surely know that both they and these are made and fashioned of thee, and are the sheep of thy flocks. May it be granted us therefore by thy benefit to enjoy peace, wherein we may serve thee in all holiness and honesty, and, being delivered from our enemies, may render thee thanks and praises.

R3.4 Ministers of the Word

Prayer. We pray also, O true Father and only Deliverer, for those whom thou hast given as pastors to thy Church, and to whom thou hast committed the care of the salvation of souls and the ministry of thy most holy Gospel: so govern and help them by thy Spirit, that they may be faithful ministers of thy glory, bending all their endeavours to this, that the flock of thy sheep, yet wandering, may gather together into one unto Jesus Christ, the true and chief Shepherd and Prince of bishops, that in him and through him they may grow more and more from day to day in all righteousness and holiness of life. Vouchsafe again to deliver

all thy churches and to snatch them out of the jaws of the wolves and the claws of all hirelings, which serve their own ambition and do all things for their own gain, caring for nothing less than that thy most holy name be everywhere renowned and holy, and thy flock attain unto salvation.

R3.5 All men

Prayer. Moreover we beseech thee, O most clement God and merciful Father, for the whole race of men: that as thou wilt be acknowledged of all throughout the whole world as the only Deliverer, redemption having been wrought through Christ thy Son, thou wouldest vouchsafe also to bring back into the right way of salvation, enlightened by thy Spirit through the preaching of the Gospel, all that are yet this day far off from the same Christ thy Son, sitting bound in darkness and in all ignorance of salvation; that they may know thee the true God, and Jesus Christ whom thou hast sent. And them whom thou hast already vouchsafed that favour, that thou hast shone into their minds by the manifestation of thy word, make them from day to day to grow richer and more blessed in all good and in the abundance of thy spiritual blessing; that at the last we may all be able with one accord truly and from the heart to adore thy Majesty and extol it with praises, and finally to deliver ourselves wholly into the keeping of thine Only-begotten, whom alone we acknowledge as our Lord, King and Lawgiver.

R3.6 The afflicted

Prayer. To these things we commend unto thee also, O God of comfort, those whom thou visitest, that thou mayest chasten them with the cross or with any kind of affliction; and the peoples whom thou now pressest with pestilence, war or famine; and lastly every one whom any want sent by thee oppresseth, or prison, or sickness, or exile, or any calamity whatsoever, be it of body or of mind. Grant that they may understand thy truly fatherly goodwill toward them, namely that thou chastenest and correctest them to this end, that being amended they may return unto thee with their whole heart, and, being delivered from all evils, may receive full consolation.

R3.7 The persecuted

Prayer. But above all we would have commended unto thee our brethren, thine elect, as many as yet live scattered under the tyranny of Antichrist, destitute of the food of spiritual life and of that liberty of thy children, that they might publicly call upon thy name; and first of all those that are in bonds or in any manner oppressed among the enemies of thy Gospel. Vouchsafe, O most indulgent Father, to increase in them the strength of thy Spirit, that they may be the firmer and never fail, but persevere constantly in thy holy calling. Be pleased ever to uphold and stay them with thy help, so far as thou knowest to be needful, and withal to comfort them in all adversities and defend them by thy care against the rage of the wolves, that through them thy name may be made more glorious both in life and in death.

R3.8 The present congregation

Prayer. Grant lastly, O God and Father, unto us that are now gathered together in the name of Jesus Christ thy Son to hear the word of the Gospel *and to communicate in the most holy mysteries of his Supper*, that we may truly acknowledge and earnestly feel how wretched and lost we are even from our first origin, provoking thy judgement against us more and more from day to day by the wickedness of our life; and so, when we have perceived how there is no good in us, and that our flesh and blood can in no wise obtain the inheritance of thy kingdom, we may give ourselves up with our whole hearts to thy only beloved Son Jesus Christ, our only Deliverer, that he may so possess us and dwell in our hearts that, the old Adam being dead and utterly done away, we may be renewed unto purity of life:

R3.9 Lord's Prayer

Rubric. Paraphrase of the Lord’s Prayer, 1–6

Prayer. 1. whereby thy name, as is meet, may be extolled with praises above all things everywhere and be made great. 2. That thou mayest also hold, yea, exercise thy right and dominion over us all, that we may learn more and more from day to day to worship thy Majesty with true obedience and due reverence; 3. and that thou alone mayest reign everywhere, the Lord of all, and govern and rule thy people by the sceptre of thy word and the power of thy Spirit, and overthrow all that oppose thee, vanquished by the might of thy truth and righteousness. So shall it come to pass that all power and height that striveth against thy glory shall little by little be destroyed and utterly overturned, until thy kingdom be made manifest, to wit, that thou alone art King and Lord, who art to come to judgement. May we also with all creatures obey thee in all things, as we know that the holy

Angels, which dwell with thee in the heavens, will have nothing else but that whatsoever is pleasing and acceptable unto thee be forthwith performed without delay according to the pleasure of thy will; and may we so study to please thee also, all the desires and pleasures of our flesh being neglected and set aside. 4. And so long as we walk before thee with love and fear of thy name, do thou of thy goodness nourish and feed us, supplying all things that be necessary for this life, that we may eat our bread in peace, whereby through thy care and solicitude for us we may be most fully persuaded that thou art the Father from whom alone all things are to be looked for, and, laying aside all trust in ourselves and in all creatures, may rest in thy goodness and benevolence alone. 5. But forasmuch as, so long as this life endureth, we miserable sinners are in the midst of death, and are so frail that we continually slip and stumble at all things, and ever wandering depart from the right: be thou in this behalf so propitious unto us, that thou pardon all these offences whereby we have made ourselves liable to thy most just judgement, and by the same pardon deliver us from eternal death, to which by our desert we are adjudged. Therefore impute not unto us this evil that we carry about, even as we also by thy commandment forget injuries, and instead of revenge pray for all good things for our enemies. 6. And finally, for the time to come uphold us by thy power, lest, falling again through the infirmity of the flesh, we offend thee. And since such is the weakness of our strength that we cannot stand firm even for a moment of time, and being beset on every side with most cruel enemies we suffer continual assault from the devil, the world and the flesh, with which we have perpetual war: strengthen us by thy Spirit and fortify us with the gifts of thy graces, that we may stand constantly against every kind of temptation, and so go on in this spiritual combat that at the last, having obtained full victory, we may triumph in thy kingdom together with our Captain and Head and highest and only Protector, the Lord Jesus Christ. Amen.

R3.10 Creed

Rubric. To this prayer the Creed is immediately added; which being recited, the precentor straightway beginneth a psalm, to which the people then sing to the end; which being sung, the pastor dismisseth the people with this good wish.

6.21 Family R4: à Lasco/Micron (London stranger church)

The London Dutch stranger church's prayer after the sermon (German version for East Frisia), still praying for the King of England and the city of London.

- **Earliest witness (archetype):** London 1554 (à Lasco/Micron).
- **Tradition:** Reformed.
- **Language:** German.
- **Form:** continuous prayer + Our Father.
- **Place in the service (London 1554 (Micron)):** Sunday morning after the sermon, the prayer for the fruit of the Word, the Decalogue, confession, declaration of loosing and binding, and the Creed; then the Our Father, and baptism, the Supper or marriage; a psalm and the blessing with a charge to remember the poor. “The great prayer for the common need” is said after every sermon.

Year	Witness	Territory	Sehling	Form
1554	London, Dutch stranger church: Marten Micron, Christlicke Ordinancien (1554; German edition 1565) (Reformed)	London Dutch refugee church (edition for East Frisia)	Sehling 7/1, IV/Ostfriesland Nr. 23 (Microns Ordinancien 1554/1565), pp. 603–604	continuous prayer + Lord’s Prayer

Sequence: R4.1 Thanksgiving > R4.2 The Church > R4.3 Civil authority > R4.4 The present congregation > R4.5 The present congregation > R4.6 The erring & unbelievers > R4.7 The persecuted > R4.8 The afflicted > R4.9 Lord's Prayer > R4.10 Special intercessions.

R4.1 Thanksgiving

Rubric. After this confession the minister beginneth the common prayer for all manner of need of the Christian congregation after this manner:

Prayer. O almighty, heavenly and merciful Father, forasmuch as it hath pleased thee of thine infinite mercy to deliver us out of the darkness of ignorance and of the Roman idolatry, and, among others, to reveal unto us the mystery of the holy Gospel of thy

dear Son, for which we give thee thanks with our whole heart: we humbly beseech thee that thou wouldest strengthen us by the grace of thy Spirit, that we may keep the true Christian faith unto the end of our life and order our life thereafter.

R4.2 The Church

Prayer. We pray thee also, most holy Father, for the common Church of thy dear Son Jesus Christ, which is scattered throughout the whole wide world, wherein the godly doctrine of thy Son is taught and maintained (the abomination and idolatry of the Roman Antichrist being rooted out). Keep from her all false shepherds and teachers, and send godly, faithful and earnest labourers into thine harvest, which seek not their own honour, but thine honour only and the edifying of thy congregation.

R4.3 Civil authority

Prayer. And first we pray, most gracious Father, for the congregation of this realm of England and for all its ministers, and especially for our most gracious lord King N. N.: preserve and keep him and govern him with thy Spirit, that he may rule his people under our common Head Jesus Christ, that we may lead under him a quiet and still life in all godliness and honesty according to thy word by thy grace. We pray also for the King's Majesty's household and the nobility, and for all lords and magistrates of the whole kingdom, and chiefly for the right wise high council of the King's Majesty: endue it with the spirit of counsel, of strength and of constancy. Give them also the spirit of unity and of peace, that in their government they may follow all that is right and good, and so help to further and maintain a Christian quiet and peace in this realm.

R4.4 The present congregation

Prayer. Endue also the whole people of this realm with thy Spirit, that it may willingly hear the voice of thy prophets, and take heed to the doctrine of thy Son Jesus Christ, and increase therein more and more from day to day; and that it may abide constant in the true obedience which it oweth to the King's Majesty and his officers, to the welfare of this realm and the edifying of the Christian congregation. We pray further thy divine grace for this city of London, that thou wouldest turn away from it all manner of plagues (which we daily deserve), and preserve it in all godliness, peace and common quiet. Govern also the magistrates thereof with thy Spirit, that they may perform their office faithfully and wisely in thy fear.

R4.5 The present congregation

Prayer. Especially we pray thee, O most gracious Father, for this our stranger congregation, that thou wouldest henceforth so show thy favour toward her, as thou hast planted her here by thy wonderful grace, that, being defended by thy power and mercy from all worldly tyranny and false doctrine, she may increase daily more and more in all godliness and true unity of hearts.

R4.6 The erring & unbelievers

Prayer. We pray thee also humbly for all kings, princes, magistrates and peoples which (being blinded with the antichristian idolatry) have not yet been able to know the voice of thy Son, and through ignorance persecute as enemies the living members of thy Son (whom they know not): that thou wouldest bring them, with all other persons blinded or (through any weakness) led astray, to the true light and the right way, that we all, gathered into one sheepfold under the one Shepherd of our souls, Christ Jesus, may praise thee with one mind for ever.

R4.7 The persecuted

Prayer. Lastly we pray also for all our brethren scattered over the whole earth, which for the right confession of thy Son and his doctrine are oppressed under the cross by Antichrist; and especially wilt thou comfort with thy Holy Spirit N. N., and so strengthen their hearts from above with thy divine power in the right faith, that they may bear all that thou sendest them patiently, manfully and with thanksgiving; and that without fear they may steadfastly confess gloriously before men thy name and the name of thy Son and make it great, be it by life or by death, as thou knowest it to serve to thine honour.

R4.8 The afflicted

Prayer. Especially we pray also for all the brethren whom thou hast justly tried and exercised with sickness, poverty, imprisonment, banishment or other misery of spirit or body, that thou wouldest not forsake them in their need, but mitigate their cross according to thy fatherly mercy, or give them strength and patience to bear steadfastly all that thou sendest them

according to thy good pleasure; that they may understand by their chastisement that they are proved of thee, as their merciful, dear Father, for the trial of their faith, and so be converted unto thee.

R4.9 Lord's Prayer

Prayer. All these things we desire of thee, most gracious Father, through thy fatherly grace and favour which thou hast shown toward us in thy Son. And in this undoubted hope we humbly call upon thy name through the same thy beloved Son Jesus Christ, as we are taught of him, saying: Our Father, which art in the heavens, etc.

R4.10 Special intercessions

Rubric. Here it is to be noted that other prayers are oftentimes added here before the Our Father is said, especially when any special concern cometh upon the congregation.

Chapter 7. The Roman Canon in German Evangelical Masses (1522–1544)

This file gives the offertory and eucharistic rites of the orders in the Sehling corpus that keep pieces of the Roman Canon and of the priest's prayers of the Ordinary, or that put a prayer of their own in the Canon's place. They were found by a search of the whole corpus (§7.1.3) and are printed in order of date.

§	Order	Sehling	eko.db doc	Pages
7.2	**Nördlingen**, Kaspar Kantz, *Von der Evangelischen Mesß*, 1522 (and 1524)	12, VIII.1	369	285–288
7.3	**Wittenberg**, Luther, *Formula missae*, 1523	1, Luther Nr. 4	2	4–9
7.4	**Allstedt**, Müntzer, *Deutsch evangelisch Messe* and *Ordnung*, 1523/24 (Radical Reformation)	1, Nr. 46–47	51, 52	500–501, 504–506
7.5	**Strasbourg**, the early German Masses, 1524–1525 (Moderate Reformed)	20, Straßburg Nr. 3	1279	120–162
7.6	**Worms**, *Deutsche Messe*, 1524 (Moderate Reformed)	19, III, Nr. 1	1066	127–129
7.7	**Nürnberg**, parish churches 1524; Volprecht 1524; *Form und Ordnung* 1525	11, I.5, I.3, I.7	249, 247, 251	46–47, 41–42, 57
7.8	**Nürnberg**, Andreas Döber's *Deutsche Messe*, 1525 (Neues Spital)	11, I.6 (exhortation: 11, I.5)	250 (249)	52–55 (48–49)
7.9	**Bremen**, *Eyne evangelysce Misse*, 1525	7, III, Nr. 1	2216	403–407
7.10	**Lippe**, Low German Mass, [1525–1538]	22, IX, Nr. 1	1549	565–569
7.11	**Schleswig-Holstein**, Low German Mass from Kiel, [after 1526]	23, A, Nr. 1	1576	55–57
7.12	**Brandenburg** (Electorate), *Kirchenordnung* of Joachim II, 1540	3, Mark Brandenburg Nr. 3	1746	67–71
7.13	**Calenberg-Göttingen**, *Kirchenordnung*, 1542	6, III	2036, 2037	813–817
7.14	**Pfalz-Neuburg**, *Kirchenordnung*, 1543	13, I.2	386	64–65, 72–76
7.15	**Bugenhagen**: Schleswig-Holstein 1542, Wolfenbüttel 1543, Hildesheim 1544 (and Braunschweig 1528)	23, A, Nr. 7; 6, I/2; 7, V	1576, 1972, 2136	89–91; 54–58; 852–856

Each order is printed from the point where the offertory stood (after the Creed or the sermon) to the dismissal. For Kantz, the Kiel Mass and Bugenhagen, the priest's preparation at the altar is included as well. The original comes first and the English follows. Annotations name the Roman text each piece comes from.

Related chapters. The rest of the Mass, and what stood around these texts, is treated elsewhere:

- the order of the Mass as a whole, the families of ordo and the ceremonial at the altar: Chapter 2, §§2.4, 2.11, 2.15;
- the preparation, the confession and absolution, and the exhortation to the communicants, collated across the corpus: Chapter 3, §§3.3–3.5;
- the collects, the abolished secret and the postcommunions: Chapter 5, §§5.5–5.6;
- the Proper Prefaces and the other propers: Chapter 4, §4.8 and Appendix 4.A;
- the hymns at the Sanctus, during the communion and after it: Chapter 8, §§8.12–8.15;
- the intercessions under the Sanctus as a family of the general prayer: Chapter 6, §6.16;
- the lights and the vestments: Chapter 14, §§14.5.4, 14.7;
- the elevation as a mark of the feast: Chapter 12, §12.10.6;
- the ministrants, deacons and subdeacons at the altar: Chapter 16, §16.4.

The German texts and the Roman comparison texts are given as the Conventions describe.

7.1 Summary of findings

The orders printed here run from Kantz's Nördlingen Mass of 1522 to Bugenhagen's Hildesheim order of 1544. Between them they show what the first generation of evangelical Masses kept of three things:

- the Roman Canon (*Te igitur* to the doxology *Per ipsum*);
- the prayers of the Ordinary around it: the offertory prayers, the embolism, the priest's prayers before and after communion, and the words of distribution;
- the rites that go with them: elevation, fraction, the Peace.

§7.1.1 summarises the findings in the order of the Mass. §7.1.2 gives the concordance tables. §7.1.3 says how the corpus was searched and which orders were examined but not printed.

7.1.1 Findings

The offertory.

- **The offertory prayers.** Luther rejected everything that "sounds of oblation" (§7.3.1). No order keeps *Suscipe, sancte Pater* (Receive, O holy Father), *Offerimus tibi* (We offer unto thee) or *Suscipe, sancta Trinitas* (Receive, O holy Trinity).
- **What does survive:**
  - **the offertory chant**: Latin in Brandenburg 1540 (§7.12.1); Müntzer's German *Ad te levavi* (Unto thee have I lifted up) (§7.4.1; Radical Reformation); a German hymn "for the offertory" in Lippe (§7.10) and Calenberg-Göttingen 1542 (§7.13.1);
  - **a rubric for preparing the chalice**: Döber (§7.8.1), Volprecht (§7.7.2), Bugenhagen's orders (§7.15.1);
  - **the *Orate fratres*, recast** as a request for prayer: Worms (Moderate Reformed; "my prayer and yours", §7.6.1), Kantz and Bremen (§7.2.1, §7.9.2), and Strasbourg (Moderate Reformed), where it becomes a bidding on Rom 12:1 to offer "our bodies" (§7.5.1, §7.5.3);
  - ***Veni, sanctificator* replaced** by the Whitsun antiphon *Veni, Sancte Spiritus* and a collect: Kantz (§7.2.2), Bremen, Kiel (§7.11.1);
  - **the Secret's closing *Per omnia saecula saeculorum. Amen***, sung before the Preface dialogue: Müntzer (§7.4.1; Radical Reformation), Lippe (§7.10), Göttingen (§7.13.1).
- **One prayer over the gifts.** Only Pfalz-Neuburg 1543 has one: Osiander's prayer "We bring … these thy gifts" (§7.14.2). It borrows from *Quam oblationem* (Which oblation), *Unde et memores* (Wherefore, mindful) and *Supplices* (We humbly [beseech]), and asks for the Spirit. Sehling's editor, after P. Graff, calls it the first Lutheran order with a kind of epiclesis (Sehling 8, p. 45, n. 12).

The Preface and Sanctus.

- **The common Preface in German:** Worms (Moderate Reformed), Kantz, Bremen.
- **Proper Prefaces in German:** Müntzer (Radical Reformation; Blessed Virgin, reworded so that God, not Mary, is praised), Strasbourg (Moderate Reformed; Cross), Lippe (Trinity), Kiel and Göttingen (Easter).
- **Luther's short Preface.** Luther cut the Preface off at *per Christum Dominum nostrum* (through Christ our Lord) and joined the Verba to it (§7.3.2). The Nürnberg Latin Mass (§7.7.1), Döber (§7.8.2) and Volprecht (§7.7.2) follow him.
- **The Sanctus after the Verba:** Luther, Döber, Volprecht and Pfalz-Neuburg.

The Canon.

- **The only continuous Canon is Worms 1524** (Moderate Reformed; §7.6.3–7.6.9). It runs from *Te igitur* (Thee therefore) to *Supplices te rogamus* (We humbly beseech thee) in German, abridged:
  - there are no saints in *Communicantes* (In communion; only its closing clause), no *Memento* of the dead, no *Nobis quoque* (To us also) and no *Per ipsum* (Through him);
  - the sacrificial nouns become "bread and wine" and "our prayer";
  - emperor and king replace pope and bishop.
- **Elsewhere single Canon prayers survive:**
  - ***Quam oblationem***, recast as a petition that the bread and wine "may become unto us" the body and blood: Kantz (§7.2.4). Bremen changes it to a prayer that "we may firmly believe" this (§7.9.3).

    - ***Unde et memores***, as a thanksgiving "after the elevation": Strasbourg (§7.5.1; Moderate Reformed). A later hand wrote the Worms text of the prayer into the Strasbourg manuscript.
- **The Canon's intercession** (the petitions of *Te igitur* and the *Memento*) survives in three ways:
    - **in the Canon's own place after the Sanctus:** Strasbourg (§7.5.1; Moderate Reformed); an optional prayer in Döber taken from Strasbourg (§7.8.11); four collects in Brandenburg (§7.12.2); three in Pfalz-Neuburg (§7.14.4); one in Göttingen (§7.13.1);
    - **as one long prayer "in place of the Canon":** Strasbourg 1525 (§7.5.2; Moderate Reformed);
    - **as the general prayer after the sermon,** which Bugenhagen calls "our Canon" (§7.15.4).
- **The Canon critique.** The Brandenburg-Nürnberg order of 1533, repeated in Brandenburg 1540 and Pfalz-Neuburg 1543, demands that the offering clauses of the Canon be replaced by "We remember the sacrifice of thine only Son" (Appendix 7.A). Sehling's register points to this critique under "Embolismus" (11:183, 13:65), because his note there explains the Würzburg embolism's added saints.

The words of institution.

- **Scripture or Canon.** Most orders read the Verba from 1 Cor 11 or a harmony of the Gospels. A distinct line keeps the Canon's own *Qui pridie* (Who the day before): *elevatis oculis* (with eyes lifted up), *benedixit* (blessed), *novi et aeterni testamenti* (of the new and eternal testament), sometimes *mysterium fidei* (the mystery of faith). The line runs through Kantz, the Nürnberg Latin Mass, Schwarz at Strasbourg (Moderate Reformed), Müntzer (Radical Reformation), Bremen, Lippe and Kiel.
- **Where Müntzer's wording travelled.** Müntzer's wording (Radical Reformation) reached Lippe, Kiel and Göttingen's proper Masses through the Erfurt *Kirchenämter* (church offices) of 1525–26 (§7.10, §7.13).
- **The elevation** is kept by Luther (at the *Benedictus*), Worms (Moderate Reformed), the Nürnberg Latin Mass, Müntzer (Radical Reformation), Strasbourg (Moderate Reformed; cup only), Brandenburg and Pfalz-Neuburg. Kantz moves it to the communion ("Behold …"). Schleswig-Holstein 1542 permits it.

The Our Father and the embolism.

- ***Praeceptis salutaribus moniti*** is recast in German almost everywhere, e.g. "Let us pray, as the Lord Christ Jesus hath commanded us …".
- **The embolism *Libera nos, quaesumus*.** Luther struck it out. What remains elsewhere:
    - **its conclusion only** ("Through our Lord Jesus … liveth and reigneth"): Worms (Moderate Reformed), Kantz, Bremen, Lippe;
    - **its sung ending *Per omnia saecula*** ("through all eternity of eternity"): Müntzer (Radical Reformation), Lippe;
    - **one line of its body** ("O Lord, deliver us from all visible and invisible enemies …"): Döber (p. 54; Sehling: "remnant of the embolism") and Strasbourg (Moderate Reformed).

The fraction.

- **Forbidden.** Luther forbids the fraction and commixture: "let the host not be broken nor mixed into the chalice" (§7.3.3). Worms (Moderate Reformed) repeats the prohibition (§7.6.11).
- **Kept in two orders only**, at the Roman place (the close of the embolism, before the Peace), and neither with the commixture:
    - the 1524 edition of Kantz's Mass, "Here let the priest take the bread and break it, as much as he needeth" (§7.2.5);
    - Müntzer's Allstedt order (Radical Reformation), where the priest "for the communicants' sake divideth the sacrament" (§7.4.3).
- **The *Deutsche Messe*** (1526) has no fraction.
- **Reformed breaking of bread.** Every other mention of breaking the bread in the corpus comes from Reformed orders from the 1550s on (à Lasco, the Palatinate, Anhalt, the Upper Palatinate, Hessen-Kassel). There the bread is broken at the distribution on the ground of 1 Cor 10:16 and Acts 2:42. It is a new rite, not a survival.

The Peace and the *Agnus Dei*.

- ***Pax Domini sit semper vobiscum*** survives widely: Worms (Moderate Reformed), Luther (as a "public absolution"), the Nürnberg Latin Mass, Müntzer (Radical Reformation), Volprecht, Brandenburg, Pfalz-Neuburg, Lippe and Göttingen. Kantz moves it into the communion.
- **The *Agnus Dei*** is kept in German or Latin by nearly all. Luther has it sung during communion.

The priest's prayers before communion.

- **All three kept.** *Domine Iesu Christe, qui dixisti*, *Domine Iesu Christe, Fili Dei vivi* (O Lord Jesus Christ, Son of the living God) and *Perceptio Corporis tui* (Let the receiving of thy Body) stay in Latin in Brandenburg (§7.12.5) and Pfalz-Neuburg (§7.14.6). Volprecht has all three in German (§7.7.2).
  - The "Libera nos" (Deliver us) in these orders is the petition inside *Fili Dei vivi* (Son of the living God; "deliver us by this thy most holy body and blood"), made plural. It is not the embolism.
- ***Fili Dei vivi* alone** is kept in German by:
  - Kantz and Bremen, abridged. Bremen changes "by this thy holy body and blood" to "by thy bottomless mercy".
  - Strasbourg (Moderate Reformed), prayed by all.
  - Döber and Kiel, said by the people line by line after the priest (§7.8.8, §7.11.3).
- ***Domine, non sum dignus*** appears once, in German, in Kiel (§7.11.3).
- ***Qui dixisti*** becomes the closing collect of the Mass in Göttingen (§7.13.3).

The words of distribution.

- **The *custodiat*** ("The body of our Lord Jesus Christ preserve thy soul unto everlasting life") is the most widespread survival. It appears in about thirty orders of the corpus, from Worms (Moderate Reformed) and Volprecht (1524) to 1609:
  - Worms (Moderate Reformed), Döber, Kantz, Bremen, the Nürnberg *Form und Ordnung*, Göttingen and many later orders;
  - most in the wording of the Albertine Saxon Agenda of 1539, "The body of our Lord Jesus Christ, given into death for thee, strengthen and preserve thee in the faith unto everlasting life";
  - Brandenburg 1540 uses it only for the communion of the sick (Sehling 3, pp. 79–80).
- ***Calicem salutaris accipiam*** (Ps 116:13) survives in Worms (Moderate Reformed), Kantz, Bremen and Volprecht.

After communion.

- ***Quod ore sumpsimus* and *Corpus tuum, Domine*.** Luther made these two ablution prayers the postcommunion (§7.3.5). Brandenburg and Pfalz-Neuburg keep them in Latin; Volprecht has both in German; Strasbourg (Moderate Reformed) has *Quod ore* (What with our mouth) as its *complenda* (completion).
- **Roman postcommunions and collects reused:**
  - Döber's *Largire sensibus nostris* (Wednesday in Holy Week). Sehling thought Döber's prayer newly composed; the identification is new here.
  - the Trinity *Proficiat* (May [the receiving] profit): Volprecht, Lippe;
  - the collect *Protector in te sperantium* (Protector of them that trust in thee): Kantz.
- **The priest's final *Placeat tibi, sancta Trinitas*** survives in Kantz, the sacrifice turned into "our praise and thanksgiving" (§7.2.7).
- **The *Nunc dimittis*** follows communion in Worms (Moderate Reformed), Döber, Kantz and Bremen.

The priest's preparation and thanksgiving.

- **Bugenhagen's preparatory prayer** is the evangelical counterpart of the prayers at the foot of the altar (§7.15):
  - in Wolfenbüttel 1543 and Hildesheim 1544, the priest kneels with the sexton and prays the *Pater noster* and the versicles *Domine, non secundum peccata nostra … Adiuva nos, Deus* (O Lord, deal not with us after our sins … Help us, O God);
  - in Schleswig-Holstein 1542 he says the *Confiteor* (I confess) privately and prays for preachers, king and realm.
- **After Mass,** Hildesheim and Schleswig-Holstein have him kneel again and "thank God secretly for himself".

How the orders are related.

- **Kantz** → Bremen (a Low German version) and the opening prayers of Kiel.
- **Müntzer** (Radical Reformation) → (Erfurt *Kirchenämter*) → Lippe, Kiel, Göttingen.
- **Strasbourg** (Moderate Reformed) → Worms (Moderate Reformed; the same Mass) and Döber's optional intercession.
- **Luther's *Formula missae*** → the Nürnberg Latin Mass, Döber, Volprecht, Brandenburg.
- **Nürnberg 1533** → the exhortation and Canon critique of Brandenburg 1540 and Pfalz-Neuburg 1543.
- **Brandenburg 1540** → Calenberg-Göttingen 1542.

7.1.2 Concordance tables

One row per order, in date order; the section number is given with each. "—" means absent; *italic* means a rubric only or a permission. "Canon form" of the Verba means the wording of *Qui pridie* (Who the day before; *elevatis oculis*, *benedixit*, *novi et aeterni testamenti*), as against the wording of 1 Cor 11 and the Gospels.

Table 1. Offertory, Preface, Sanctus

Order	Offertory chant	Offertory prayers, *Orate fratres*	The Secret's *Per omnia saecula* (World without end)	Preface	Sanctus
Kantz 1522 (§7.2)	—	*Orate fratres* recast; *Veni Sancte Spiritus* (Come, Holy Spirit) for *Veni sanctificator*	—	German, common	German, before the Canon
Luther, *FM* 1523 (§7.3)	—	*forbidden* (all "sounds of oblation")	—	Latin, cut at *per Christum* (through Christ), runs into the Verba	after the Verba
Müntzer 1523/24 (§7.4; Radical Reformation)	*Ad te levavi* (Unto thee have I lifted up), German	— ("We hold no sacrifice")	"through all eternity of eternity. Amen"	German, proper (Blessed Virgin, reworded)	German, before
Strasbourg 1524–25 (§7.5; Moderate Reformed)	—	bidding on Rom 12:1 for *Orate fratres*; *lavabo* kept	—	German, proper (Cross); 1525 common; last form none	German, before; last form none
Worms 1524 (§7.6; Moderate Reformed)	—	*Orate fratres*, German ("my prayer and yours")	—	German, common	German, before
Nürnberg parishes 1524, *Form* 1525 (§7.7.1, §7.7.3)	*omitted*	*omitted*	—	Latin, cut at *per Christum*	Latin, during or after *Qui pridie*
Volprecht 1524 (§7.7.2)	—	*chalice prepared*	—	German, cut, runs into the Verba	after the Verba
Döber 1525 (§7.8)	—	*chalice prepared after the Gradual*	—	German, cut (Luther's form)	German, after the Verba
Bremen 1525 (§7.9)	—	as Kantz	—	as Kantz	before
Lippe [1525–38] (§7.10)	German hymn	—	"Through all eternity of eternity, amen"	German, Trinity	before
Kiel [after 1526] (§7.11)	—	Kantz's *Veni* and collect, before the altar	—	German, Easter	(text breaks off)
Brandenburg 1540 (§7.12)	Latin; German psalm in villages	—	—	Latin, of the day	Latin, four German collects under it

Order	Offertory chant	Offertory prayers, *Orate fratres*	The Secret's *Per omnia saecula* (World without end)	Preface	Sanctus
Calenberg-Göttingen 1542 (§7.13)	German psalm "in place of the offertory"	—	"God be praised from eternity to eternity. Amen"	German, Easter	Luther's German Sanctus, a collect under it
Pfalz-Neuburg 1543 (§7.14)	—	Osiander's prayer over the gifts ("We bring … these thy gifts")	—	—	after the Verba, three collects under it
Bugenhagen 1528–44 (§7.15)	German hymn while bread and wine are prepared	—	—	Latin, on feasts only	Latin or German, on feasts

Table 2. The Canon and the words of institution

Order	Intercession (*Te igitur*, *Memento*)	Other Canon prayers	Verba	Elevation
Kantz 1522 (§7.2)	—	*Quam oblationem* (Which oblation) recast	Canon form	moved to the communion ("Behold …")
Luther, *FM* 1523 (§7.3)	—	—	Scriptural	yes, at the *Benedictus*
Müntzer 1523/24 (§7.4; Radical Reformation)	—	—	Canon form, with *mysterium fidei* (the mystery of faith)	bread elevated, cup shown
Strasbourg 1524–25 (§7.5; Moderate Reformed)	after the Sanctus, for rulers and the congregation; 1525: long prayer "in place of the Canon"	"Post elevationem" (After the elevation) prayer in the place of *Unde et memores* (Wherefore, mindful)	Canon-based; *mysterium fidei* added by a later hand; 1525: 1 Cor 11 read as a lesson	cup only; 1525: none
Worms 1524 (§7.6; Moderate Reformed)	*Te igitur* and *Memento*, German (emperor and king for pope and bishop)	continuous Canon to *Supplices* (We humbly [beseech]): end of *Communicantes* (In communion), *Hanc igitur*, *Quam oblationem*, *Unde et memores*, *Supra quae* (Upon which), *Supplices*	Canon form ("new and everlasting testament")	yes
Nürnberg parishes 1524, *Form* 1525 (§7.7.1, §7.7.3)	—	—	Canon form, Latin, with *mysterium fidei*	bread and cup
Volprecht 1524 (§7.7.2)	—	—	Scriptural	—

Order	Intercession (*Te igitur*, *Memento*)	Other Canon prayers	Verba	Elevation
Döber 1525 (§7.8)	optional *gemein gebet* (common prayer; from Strasbourg, Moderate Reformed)	—	German ("into his holy hands")	"showeth it to the people"
Bremen 1525 (§7.9)	—	*Quam oblationem* recast as a prayer to believe	Canon form	—
Lippe [1525–38] (§7.10)	—	—	Canon form, with *mysterium fidei*	—
Kiel [after 1526] (§7.11)	—	—	Canon form; cup consecrated after the bread is given	—
Brandenburg 1540 (§7.12)	four collects under the Sanctus	—	Scriptural, sung	yes
Calenberg-Göttingen 1542 (§7.13)	collect for the magistrates under the Sanctus	—	Scriptural	—
Pfalz-Neuburg 1543 (§7.14)	three collects under the Sanctus	echoes of *Quam oblationem*, *Unde et memores*, *Supplices* in Osiander's prayer	Scriptural, sung	yes
Bugenhagen 1528–44 (§7.15)	general prayer after the sermon ("our Canon")	—	Scriptural; bread and cup separately	*permitted* (1542)

Table 3. From the Our Father to the *Agnus Dei*

Order	*Praeceptis salutaribus* (Taught by saving precepts)	Embolism	Fraction	*Pax Domini* (The peace of the Lord)	*Agnus Dei* (Lamb of God)
Kantz 1522 (§7.2)	"Let us pray"	conclusion only	*1524 edition only*	at the communion ("The peace be with you all")	German, once
Luther, *FM* 1523 (§7.3)	Latin	*forbidden*	*forbidden*	yes, as absolution	during communion
Müntzer 1523/24 (§7.4; Radical Reformation)	recast	sung ending *Per omnia* (World without end)	*yes* ("for the communicants' sake")	yes, with response	German
Strasbourg 1524–25 (§7.5; Moderate Reformed)	recast	one-line remnant	—	—	German
Worms 1524 (§7.6; Moderate Reformed)	German	conclusion only	*forbidden*	yes, as absolution	German, once

Order	***Praeceptis salutaribus* (Taught by saving precepts)**	**Embolism**	**Fraction**	***Pax Domini* (The peace of the Lord)**	***Agnus Dei* (Lamb of God)**
Nürnberg parishes 1524, *Form* 1525 (§7.7.1, §7.7.3)	Latin	—	—	Latin	Latin, during communion; 1525 German
Volprecht 1524 (§7.7.2)	recast	—	—	German, with response	German, thrice
Döber 1525 (§7.8)	recast from Mt 6	one-line remnant	—	"The Lord be with you"	German, twice
Bremen 1525 (§7.9)	"Let us pray"	conclusion only	—	—	German, once
Lippe [1525–38] (§7.10)	recast (Müntzer, Radical Reformation)	conclusion and *Per omnia*	—	yes, with response	German, twice
Kiel [after 1526] (§7.11)	— (no Our Father)	—	—	—	—
Brandenburg 1540 (§7.12)	recast	—	—	yes	Latin, thrice
Calenberg-Göttingen 1542 (§7.13)	recast (Brandenburg)	—	—	German, after communion	Decius' hymn, after the thanksgiving
Pfalz-Neuburg 1543 (§7.14)	"Let us pray!"	—	—	yes	Latin, thrice
Bugenhagen 1528–44 (§7.15)	—	—	—	—	German

Table 4. Communion and after

Order	**Priest's prayers before communion**	**Words of distribution**	**Ablution prayers (*Quod ore*, *Corpus tuum*)**	**Postcommunion**	**Close**
Kantz 1522 (§7.2)	*Fili Dei vivi* (Son of the living God), German, abridged	*custodiat* (preserve), to all; *Calicem salutaris* (The cup of salvation), plural	—	collect *Protector in te sperantium* (Protector of them that trust in thee)	*Nunc dimittis*; *Placeat* in German
Luther, *FM* 1523 (§7.3)	*Fili Dei vivi*, *permitted*, plural	*custodiat*, *permitted*	as the postcommunion	*Quod ore sumpsimus* (What we have taken with our mouth)	*Benedicamus*; Aaronic blessing
Müntzer 1523/24 (§7.4; Radical Reformation)	—	—	—	new	*Benedicamus*
Strasbourg 1524–25 (§7.5; Moderate Reformed)	*Fili Dei vivi*, German, prayed by all	1525: "Remember, believe, proclaim …"	*Quod ore*, German	*Quod ore* as *complenda* (completion)	Trinitarian blessing

Order	Priest's prayers before communion	Words of distribution	Ablution prayers (*Quod ore*, *Corpus tuum*)	Postcommunion	Close
Worms 1524 (§7.6; Moderate Reformed)	—	*custodiat*, German; *Calicem salutaris*	echoed in the postcommunion	German, from *Perceptio* and *Corpus tuum*	*Nunc dimittis*; Trinitarian blessing
Nürnberg parishes 1524, *Form* 1525 (§7.7.1, §7.7.3)	—	1525: *custodiat*, German	—	proper *complenda*	1525: *Benedicamus*
Volprecht 1524 (§7.7.2)	*Qui dixisti* (Who saidst), *Fili Dei vivi*, *Perceptio*, German	*custodiat* (priest); *Calicem salutaris*	both, German	Trinity *Proficiat* (May [the receiving] profit)	Aaronic blessing; *Benedicamus*
Döber 1525 (§7.8)	*Fili Dei vivi*, German, said by the people	*custodiat*, German	—	*Largire sensibus nostris*	*Nunc dimittis*; Aaronic and Trinitarian blessing
Bremen 1525 (§7.9)	*Fili Dei vivi*, "through thy bottomless mercy"	*custodiat*; *Calicem salutaris*	—	—	*Nunc dimittis*; *Te Deum* (We praise thee, O God)
Lippe [1525–38] (§7.10)	—	—	—	Trinity *Proficiat*	*Benedicamus*; Aaronic blessing
Kiel [after 1526] (§7.11)	*Fili Dei vivi*, said by the people; *Domine, non sum dignus* (Lord, I am not worthy)	—	—	a collect	Aaronic blessing
Brandenburg 1540 (§7.12)	*Qui dixisti*, *Fili Dei vivi*, *Perceptio*, Latin	"Take and eat …" (*custodiat* only for the sick)	both, Latin	Nürnberg 1533 thanksgiving	—
Calenberg-Göttingen 1542 (§7.13)	—	*custodiat*, German	—	Brandenburg thanksgiving	*Qui dixisti* as the final collect; Easter *Benedicamus*; Aaronic blessing
Pfalz-Neuburg 1543 (§7.14)	*Qui dixisti*, *Fili Dei vivi*, *Perceptio*, Latin	"Take and eat …"	both, Latin	the same thanksgiving, split in two	*Benedicamus*; Aaronic or other blessings
Bugenhagen 1528–44 (§7.15)	—	none: nothing is said at the distribution	—	Luther's "We give thanks to thee"	Aaronic blessing; private thanksgiving (1542, 1544)

7.1.3 Method, and orders examined but not printed

The corpus (`eko.db`, all volumes of Sehling) was searched with regular expressions for:

- the priest's prayers *Qui dixisti* (Who saidst), *Fili Dei vivi* (Son of the living God), *Perceptio*, *Domine non sum dignus* (Lord, I am not worthy), *Corpus … custodiat* (The body … preserve), *Quod ore sumpsimus* (What we have taken with our mouth) and *Corpus tuum* (Thy body);
- Canon incipits and the Canon form of the Verba ("hub auf seine augen", "neuen und ewigen");
- offertory language and blessing of the gifts;
- the fraction ("breche", "teilet", *frangatur*, *fractio*);
- the embolism;
- Sehling's register entries *Offertorium* (Offertory), *Kanongebet* (Canon prayer), *Messkanon*, *canon missae* (canon of the Mass), *Epiklese* (epiclesis), *Konsekration* (consecration) and *Postcommunio* (postcommunion).

Every hit was read in context. The following orders were examined and are not printed:

Order	Why not printed
Luther, *Deutsche Messe*, 1526 (Sehling 1, doc 3)	No Canon or Ordinary prayers (see §7.3.6).
Homberg, *Reformatio ecclesiarum Hassiae*, 1526 (Moderate Reformed; Sehling 8, doc 2247, pp. 44–45)	Rules only: "Let that Canon of the Mass, and all the prayers in which the word sacrifice or victim is found, be said by no one any more at this Supper". Luther's German Mass is prescribed.
Braunschweig 1528, Hamburg 1529 / Lübeck 1531, Pomerania 1535 (Bugenhagen)	Latin Preface and Sanctus on feasts only, otherwise as §7.15.
Heilbronn 1530 (Sehling 17, doc 770, pp. 276–277)	Quotes *Te igitur* (Thee therefore), *Quam oblationem* (Which oblation) and *Supra quae* (Upon which) only to refute them.
Transylvania, Honterus, 1543/47 (Sehling 24, docs 1669–1670)	"the Canon being rejected": Preface, Sanctus, Our Father and Verba, with the Saxon *custodiat* (1547).
Corvinus, *Kirchenordnung* 1542 (Sehling 21, doc 1460)	Luther's paraphrase and the Verba. The distribution "Take, eat and remember …" is Strasbourg's "Gedenckent, glaubent" (Remember, believe) type (§7.5.2; Moderate Reformed), not the *custodiat* (preserve).
Schwäbisch Hall 1543 (Sehling 17, doc 762) and its communion of the sick, 1537 (doc 761)	*Custodiat* (Preserve) only ("The body of our Lord Christ preserve thee unto everlasting life").
Later Upper German orders, e.g. Sehling 16, V, 1560 (doc 742), after Basel 1526 (Reformed)	A prayer before communion that echoes the *Perceptio*: "that we may receive thy Supper not unto judgement, but unto everlasting life".
Reformed orders (Kurpfalz from 1563, Anhalt, Hessen-Kassel, à Lasco)	No Canon prayers; the breaking of bread is a new rite (§7.1.1).

7.2 Nördlingen, Kaspar Kantz, *Von der Evangelischen Meß*, 1522

Von der Evangelischen Meß. Mit schönen Christlichen Gebetten vor und nach der empfahung des Sacraments. Durch Caspar Kantz von Nördlingen. (Of the Evangelical Mass. With fine Christian prayers before and after the receiving of the Sacrament. By Caspar Kantz of Nördlingen.) Sehling 12, VIII.1, pp. 285–288 (`eko.db` doc 369). Sehling's base text is the print of 1522. The apparatus gives the changes of the second edition, *Die rechte evangelische und apostolische Meß*, 1524 ("II").

This is the earliest German evangelical Mass in the corpus. It is the source of the Bremen Mass of 1525 (§7.9), and its opening prayers reappear in the Kiel Low German Mass (§7.11). The Mass has no offertory. In its place Kantz puts:

- an address and absolution;
- a recast *Orate fratres*;
- the *Veni Sancte Spiritus* (Come, Holy Spirit) antiphon.

Then comes the common Preface and Sanctus. The Canon is cut down to one prayer, a recast *Quam oblationem* (Which oblation) that flows into *Qui pridie* (Who the day before). The rubric in front of it says: "Only now does the evangelical Mass begin".

7.2.1 Address, absolution and the recast *Orate fratres*

First the priest, or another, shall make an exhortation concerning the sacrament, or else say somewhat comfortable out of the holy Gospel, as the Spirit of God giveth it him, etc. Thereafter he may address them that sit by with such or other words: Dearly beloved in Christ! That ye may with joyful and desirous hearts receive the tender body and rose-coloured blood of our Saviour Jesus Christ, humble your hearts before God, confess unto him your sins and infirmities with hearty desire, and long after his divine grace and help! So will I now, your chosen priest, impart unto you the holy absolution, and pray God for you. The almighty and merciful God forgive you your sins! And I, by the commandment of our Lord Jesus Christ, in the stead of the holy Church, pronounce you free, quit and loosed of all your sins, in the name of the Father and of the Son and of the Holy Ghost. Amen. But forasmuch as I also am burdened with manifold infirmities, pray God faithfully for me, that I may diligently perform and finish this his service to his praise, to your comfort and mine, and to our salvation. Psalm 123: Our help shall be in the name of the Lord, who hath made heaven and earth.

Note.

- **The absolution.** Sehling's note: it is put together from the *Indulgentiam* (Pardon) at the beginning of the Mass and the absolution of private confession.
- **The request for prayer.** "But forasmuch as I also am burdened … therefore pray God faithfully for me" is, in Sehling's words, a "free recasting of the *Orate, fratres*". The Roman request is "that my sacrifice and yours may be acceptable". Here the priest asks for help to perform "this his service".
- **The versicle.** *Adiutorium nostrum in nomine Domini* (Our help is in the name of the Lord; Ps 124:8, numbered 123 in the Vulgate) belongs to the prayers at the foot of the altar.
- **The 1524 edition** drops the lay minister ("or another") and the psalm verse, and heads the absolution "The absolution".

7.2.2 *Veni Sancte Spiritus* and collect (in place of *Veni sanctificator*)

Thereafter the priest shall kneel down and say: Now let us pray; say ye all secretly with me: Come, Holy Ghost, fill the hearts of thy faithful, and kindle in them the fire of thy divine love, who through the diversity of tongues hast gathered the peoples of the whole world in the unity of the faith. Alleluia. O Lord, almighty God, grant that thy Holy Ghost may be and dwell with us, that he may enlighten us and teach us all truth, and defend and strengthen us in all adversity; through Christ our Lord! Amen.

Note.

- **The antiphon.** This is the Whitsun Vigil antiphon *Veni, Sancte Spiritus, reple tuorum corda fidelium* (Come, Holy Spirit, fill the hearts of thy faithful). Sehling notes that the diocese of Augsburg prayed it in the Mass in place of the offertory prayer *Veni, sanctificator*. The rubric keeps the posture of the offertory prayers (kneeling, "secretly") but has the whole congregation say them.
- **The collect.** This is not a Roman offertory prayer. It resembles the Whitsuntide collect "May the power of the Holy Spirit be present with us, we beseech thee, O Lord, … and defend us from all adversities", with "teach all truth" from John 16:13. The same collect opens the Bremen (§7.9) and Kiel (§7.11) Masses.

7.2.3 Preface and Sanctus

The Preface, or foreword of the Mass: Lift up your hearts unto God, and let us give thanks unto God our Lord; for that is meet and right! Yea, verily it is meet and right, and also wholesome, that we should in all places and at all times give thanks unto thee, O Lord, holy Father, almighty, everlasting God, through Christ our Lord, through whom all angels and the heavenly powers worship, honour and praise thy glorious majesty. With the same, we beseech thee, vouchsafe to admit and receive our voice, that we also may praise thee and say without end: *Sanctus:* Holy, holy, holy, Lord God of Sabaoth; heaven and earth are full of thy glory. Hosanna in the highest! Blessed be he that cometh in the name of the Lord. Luck and salvation in the highest!

Note.

- **The dialogue.** It is reduced to the priest's words, with the responses run in: *Sursum corda … Gratias agamus … Dignum et iustum est* (Lift up your hearts … Let us give thanks … It is meet and right).

- **The Preface.** This is the common Preface ("It is very meet … through Christ our Lord. Through whom the Angels praise thy majesty, the Dominions adore … with whom we pray thee that thou wouldest bid our voices also to be admitted"). The ranks of angels are merged into "all angels and the heavenly powers".
- **The Sanctus.** The second *Hosanna* is rendered "luck and salvation" (Ps 118:25, "O Lord, send now prosperity").

7.2.4 *Quam oblationem* and *Qui pridie*

Here beginneth first the evangelical Mass. O most gracious Father, merciful, everlasting God, grant that this bread and the wine may become and be unto us the true body and the innocent blood of thy most dear Son, our Lord Jesus Christ; who on the day before his passion took the bread into his holy hands, looked up to heaven unto thee, his almighty Father, gave thanks, blessed, and brake the bread, and gave it to his disciples, saying: Take, and eat! This is my body, which is given for you. Likewise after the supper he took the cup into his holy hands, gave thanks, blessed, and gave it to his disciples, and said: Take, and drink ye all of it! This is the cup of the new and everlasting testament in my blood, which is shed for you and for many for the remission of sins. As oft as ye do this, do it in remembrance of me!

Note.

- **The rubric.** "Now first beginneth the evangelical Mass": everything before is preparation. The Canon proper begins here, with the one Canon prayer that is kept.
- **The recast *Quam oblationem*.** Sehling calls it "the prayer after the conclusion of the Canon prayer *Quam oblationem*". The Roman text is "Which oblation do thou, O God, vouchsafe, we beseech thee, in all things to make blessed, approved, ratified, reasonable and acceptable, that it may become for us the Body and Blood of thy most beloved Son our Lord Jesus Christ". Kantz keeps the petition *ut nobis … fiat* (that for us … it may become) and the superlative *dilectissimi* (most beloved). He drops the oblation and its five adjectives. The object becomes "this bread and the wine".
- ***Qui pridie*** keeps *elevatis oculis in caelum ad te Deum Patrem suum omnipotentem* (with eyes lifted up to heaven unto thee, God, his almighty Father) ("he looked up to heaven unto thee, his almighty Father"), both *benedixit* (blessed), and *novi et aeterni testamenti* (of the new and eternal testament). It drops *mysterium fidei* (the mystery of faith).
  - "for you and for many" is *pro vobis et pro multis* (for you and for many).
  - "As oft as ye do this, so do it in my remembrance" is *Haec quotiescumque feceritis, in mei memoriam facietis* (As often as ye shall do these things, ye shall do them in remembrance of me).
- **The 1524 edition** has "supper" for "evening meal", and "into his worthy hands, but giveth thanks, blesseth it" (*venerabiles manus*).

7.2.5 Our Father with the conclusion of the embolism; *Agnus Dei*; *Fili Dei vivi*

Let us pray: Our Father, which art in heaven, hallowed be thy name! Thy kingdom come! Thy will be done, as in heaven, so in earth! Give us this day our daily bread, and forgive us our debts, as we forgive our debtors! And lead us not into temptation, but deliver us from evil! Through our Lord Jesus, thy Son, who with thee and the Holy Ghost, one true God, liveth and reigneth for ever. Amen. *Agnus Dei:* O thou Lamb of God, that bearest the sin of the world, have mercy upon us and give us thy peace! Amen. *A devout prayer before the receiving of the sacrament:* O Lord Jesu Christ, thou everlasting Word of the Father, thou Saviour of the world, thou true, living God and man, deliver us by this thy holy body and rose-coloured blood from all sins! Help us that we may fulfil thy commandments at all times, and never be parted from thee for ever! Amen.

Note.

- **The end of the embolism.** As at Worms (§7.6.10; Moderate Reformed), the Our Father runs straight into the conclusion of *Libera nos, quaesumus* (Deliver us, we beseech thee; "Through the same Jesus Christ our Lord, thy Son, who liveth and reigneth with thee in the unity of the Holy Spirit, God"). The body of the embolism is gone.
- **The fraction, in the 1524 edition only.** The 1524 edition adds the doxology "for thine is the kingdom and the power and the glory for ever. Amen." It then adds a rubric before the conclusion:

  Here let the priest take the bread and break it, as much as he needeth, and say:

  - **Where the rubric falls.** Sehling's note 7 points out that the Roman fraction came at these same words, at the end of the embolism. There the priest broke the host in three and dropped one piece into the chalice. In 1524 the conclusion "Through our Lord …" stands isolated after the doxology's *Amen*, so the breaking marks the old place.

- **Was it new in 1524?** Sehling judges (notes 7–9) that the 1522 edition did not know the fraction. There the priest shows "a host", any host, while in 1524 he shows "the [host]", the host just broken.
- **No commixture.** Neither edition drops a piece into the cup.

- **The *Agnus Dei*.** It is sung once, with *dona nobis pacem* (grant us peace).

- ***Fili Dei vivi*.** The prayer before communion is an abridged "O Lord Jesus Christ, Son of the living God, … deliver me by this thy most holy Body and Blood from all mine iniquities and from all evils, and make me always to cleave to thy commandments, and suffer me never to be separated from thee".

  - The opening clause (*qui ex voluntate Patris* …, who by the will of the Father …) gives way to a string of titles.
  - The prayer is plural throughout.
  - The 1524 edition heads it "Oratio" (Prayer).

7.2.6 Communion, with the *custodiat* and *Calicem salutaris*

After this prayer let the priest receive the sacrament, if he be otherwise prepared thereto, and then take a host in his hand, show or point it to the communicants, and say thus: Behold, dearly beloved, this is verily the holy body of our Lord Jesus Christ, which suffered for you the bitter death. Take and eat it, that it may feed, nourish and preserve you unto everlasting life! Amen. Peace be with you all! *When he hath now communicated them all with the holy body of Christ, let him say thus:* Let us also drink the cup of salvation and call upon the name of our Lord! *And when he hath drunk, he shall turn him to them with the chalice or cup, and say thus:* Behold, this is verily the precious treasure of the costly blood of our Lord Jesus Christ, wherewith ye are bought. Take it, and divide it among you, to the washing away of your sins!

Note.

- **"Behold …".** The showing of the host with "Behold" takes the place of the elevation (Sehling: "The elevation, which Kantz has thus moved from the act of consecration into the communion"). It also recalls the *Ecce Agnus Dei* (Behold the Lamb of God) of the late-medieval communion of the people.
- **"… that he feed, nourish and preserve you unto everlasting life"** is the *custodiat* (preserve) formula ("The body of our Lord Jesus Christ preserve thy soul unto everlasting life"), spoken to all at once.
- **"The peace be with you all".** The *Pax Domini* (The peace of the Lord) has moved from before the *Agnus Dei* (Lamb of God) to the communion. The 1524 edition makes it "The peace be with thee!", said to each communicant.
- **"Let us also drink the cup of salvation …"** is the priest's *Calicem salutaris accipiam, et nomen Domini invocabo* (I will take the cup of salvation, and call upon the name of the Lord; Ps 116:13), from his prayers at the sumption. It is turned into a plural invitation.
- **The cup.** "divide it among you" echoes Luke 22:17.

7.2.7 Thanksgiving: *Nunc dimittis*, *Te Deum*, collects

When that is done, the priest shall kneel down and give thanks: O Lord, now lettest thou thy servants depart in peace according to thy word; for our eyes have seen thy salvation, which thou hast prepared before the face of all peoples, a light to lighten the Gentiles, and to be the glory of thy people Israel. Unto thee be praise, honour and thanks, O thou holy, blessed, glorious Trinity, God the Father, Son and Holy Ghost! Amen. *Item, for thanksgiving one may say:* Te Deum laudamus. We praise thee, O God; we acknowledge thee to be the Lord. […] Lord, now lettest thou thy servant depart in peace, according to thy word […]. Glory be to the Father, etc., as it was in the beginning, is now, and ever shall be, world without end. Amen. O gracious and merciful God, the strength of all that hope in thee, help us so to walk through things temporal that we lose not the things eternal; through Christ our Lord. Amen. O thou holy Trinity, let our praise and thanksgiving be well-pleasing unto thee! Make firm and steadfast the work which thou hast wrought in us! Grant that it may be fruitful and profitable unto us unto everlasting life! Amen.

Note.

- **The *Nunc dimittis*.** Made plural ("thy servants", "our eyes"). Sehling notes it was among the priest's silent prayers at this point in some German churches.
- **The first collect.** Sehling identifies it as the collect of the third Sunday after Pentecost, "O God, the protector of all that trust in thee … that we may so pass through things temporal that we lose not the things eternal", not a postcommunion.

- **The Trinity prayer is the *Placeat*.** Sehling thought it "probably composed by Kantz". It is in fact the priest's last prayer of the Roman Mass, said before the blessing: "May the homage of my bounden duty be pleasing to thee, O holy Trinity; and grant that the sacrifice which I, unworthy, have offered in the sight of thy majesty may be acceptable to thee, and through thy mercy be a propitiation for me and for all those for whom I have offered it".
  - "let our praise and thanksgiving be well pleasing to thee" is *placeat tibi … obsequium* (may the homage … be pleasing to thee).
  - The sacrifice offered becomes "the work which thou hast wrought in us": God's work in us, not ours before him.
  - "fruitful and profitable … unto everlasting life" takes the place of *propitiabile* (a propitiation).
- **What follows.** The order ends by permitting the Latin *Te Deum* (We praise thee, O God) and the Magnificat "for thanksgiving". There is no blessing.

7.3 Wittenberg, Luther, *Formula missae et communionis*, 1523

Sehling 1, Martin Luther's Ordnungen Nr. 4, pp. 4–9 (`eko.db` doc 2; the database dates the document 1889, the year of Sehling's volume). The order is in Latin. It is included because it is the model the German Masses answer to. Brandenburg 1540 (§7.12) takes its Latin communion prayers from the permissions given here. The Nürnberg Latin order of 1524 (§7.7.1) takes its shortened Preface from it.

Luther states the rule first: everything that "sounds of oblation", with the whole Canon, is to go. What is "pure and holy" stays. The paragraphs below are numbered as in the print.

7.3.1 The rule, and the preparation of bread and wine

Eighthly, there followeth all that abomination, to which everything that went before in the Mass was forced to serve, whence also it is called the offertory. And from here on almost everything soundeth and savoureth of oblation. […] Therefore, all those things being rejected which sound of oblation, together with the whole Canon, let us retain those things which are pure and holy, and so begin our Mass. I. During the Creed, or after the canon [*sermon*], let bread and wine be made ready for the blessing in the accustomed manner; save that I have not yet determined with myself whether water be to be mixed with the wine, though I incline to this, that pure wine rather be prepared without the mixture of water […]. Yet I will not bring in a superstitious law against liberty.

Note.

- **"post canonem" (after the canon).** This is Sehling's reading. The Weimar edition (WA 12, 211) reads *post concionem*, "after the sermon". That fits the paragraph before, which lets the vernacular sermon come after the Creed.
- **What goes.** The offertory prayers (*Suscipe, sancte Pater*; *Offerimus tibi*; *Veni, sanctificator*; *Suscipe, sancta Trinitas*), the *Orate fratres*, the Secret and the whole Canon, as all "sounding of oblation".
- **What stays** is set out in §§II–VIII below.

7.3.2 Preface, Verba, Sanctus with elevation

II. The bread and wine being made ready, let him straightway proceed after this manner: "The Lord be with you"; answer, "And with thy spirit". "Lift up your hearts"; answer, "Let us lift them up unto the Lord". "Let us give thanks unto the Lord our God". Answer: "It is meet and right. It is very meet and right, fitting and wholesome, that we should at all times and in all places give thanks unto thee, O Lord, holy Father, almighty, everlasting God, through Christ our Lord". III. Then: "Who the day before he suffered took bread, giving thanks, brake it, and gave it to his disciples, saying: Take, eat; this is my body, which is given for you. Likewise also the cup, after he had supped, saying: This cup is the new testament in my blood, which shall be shed for you and for many for the remission of sins. As oft as ye shall do these things, ye shall do them in remembrance of me." These words of Christ I would have recited, after a short pause interposed after the Preface, in that tone of voice in which the Lord's Prayer is otherwise sung in the Canon, so that they may be heard by them that stand about; although in all these things let godly minds have liberty to recite those words either silently or aloud. IV. The blessing being ended, let the choir sing the Sanctus, and during the singing of the Benedictus let the bread and cup be elevated after the rite hitherto kept, chiefly for the sake of the weak, who might perhaps be offended by a sudden change of this more notable rite in the Mass, especially where they have been taught by sermons in the vulgar tongue what is sought by that elevation.

Note.

- **The Preface.** It is cut off after *per Christum Dominum nostrum* (through Christ our Lord). The Verba follow as a relative clause on *Christum* (Christ; "Qui pridie …"). This is the form Nürnberg took up in 1524 (§7.7.1) and the German orders of Volprecht (§7.7.2) and Döber (§7.8.2) translated.
- ***Qui pridie*** is reduced to the Gospel and Pauline wording.
  - Gone are *in sanctas ac venerabiles manus suas* (into his holy and venerable hands), *elevatis oculis* (with eyes lifted up), *benedixit* (blessed), *aeterni* (eternal) and *mysterium fidei* (the mystery of faith).
  - "which is given for you" (Luke 22:19) and "this cup is the new testament in my blood" (1 Cor 11:25) come from Scripture, not the Missal.
- **"benedictio" (blessing).** Luther calls the recitation of the Verba the "benedictio".
- **The Sanctus and elevation.** The Sanctus, which in the Roman Mass comes before the Canon, is moved after the Verba. The elevation is kept "with the rite kept hitherto", during the *Benedictus*.

7.3.3 Our Father; no embolism, no fraction; the Peace as absolution

V. After these things let the Lord's Prayer be read, thus: "Let us pray. Taught by wholesome precepts, etc.", the prayer following, "Deliver us, we beseech thee", being omitted, with all the signs that are wont to be made over the host and with the host over the chalice; and let the host not be broken, nor mixed into the chalice. But straightway after the Lord's Prayer let there be said "The peace of the Lord, etc.", which is a kind of public absolution from the sins of the communicants, a voice plainly evangelical, announcing remission of sins, that one and most worthy preparation for the Lord's table, if it be laid hold on by faith, no otherwise than as spoken from the mouth of Christ. Wherefore I would have it announced with the face turned to the people, as bishops are wont to do, which is the only trace of the ancient bishops left in our bishops.

Note.

- **The embolism** ("Deliver us, we beseech thee, O Lord, from all evils …", Deliver us, we beseech thee, O Lord, from all evils …) is struck out, with its signs of the cross made over the host and the chalice with a fragment.
- **The fraction and commixture are forbidden.** "let the host not be broken nor mixed into the chalice". Worms 1524 (Moderate Reformed) repeats this in German (§7.6.11). Of the evangelical orders in the corpus, only Kantz's second edition (1524, §7.2.5) and Müntzer's Allstedt order (§7.4.2; Radical Reformation) break the bread at this point.
- **The Peace.** *Pax Domini sit semper vobiscum* (The peace of the Lord be always with you) is reinterpreted as a public absolution. Worms (Moderate Reformed) and Brandenburg keep it in that sense.

7.3.4 Communion: *Agnus Dei*, *Fili Dei vivi*, *custodiat*

VI. Then let him communicate first himself, then the people; meanwhile let the Agnus Dei be sung. But if he will pray before the sumption that prayer, "O Lord Jesus Christ, Son of the living God, who by the will of the Father, etc.", he shall not pray amiss, only changing the singular number into the plural, "our" and "us" for "my" and "me". Likewise also that other: "The body of the Lord, etc., preserve my soul, or thy soul, unto life eternal". And "The blood of our Lord preserve thy soul unto life eternal".

Note.

- **What is permitted.** Of the three prayers before the priest's communion, only *Domine Iesu Christe, Fili Dei vivi* (O Lord Jesus Christ, Son of the living God) is allowed, and it is made plural. *Domine Iesu Christe, qui dixisti* (O Lord Jesus Christ, who saidst) and *Perceptio corporis* (Let the receiving of [thy] body) are not mentioned. Brandenburg 1540 nevertheless kept all three (§7.12.5).
- **The *custodiat*.** It serves both for the priest ("meam") and for each communicant ("tuam").
- **The *Agnus Dei*.** It is sung during communion, not before it.

7.3.5 Communion chant; *Quod ore sumpsimus* and *Corpus tuum* for the postcommunion;

Benedicamus; blessing

VII. If it please them to sing the communion, let it be sung. But in the place of the complenda or last collect, because they almost all sound of sacrifice, let that prayer be read in the same tone: "What we have taken with our mouth, O Lord". That other also may be read: "Thy body, O Lord, which we have received, etc.", the number being changed into the plural. "Who livest and reignest, etc." "The Lord be with you, etc." In the place of "Ite, missa est" (Go, it is the dismissal) let there be said "Let us bless the Lord", with Alleluia added (where and when it pleaseth) in its own melodies; or let the Benedicamus be borrowed from Vespers.

VIII. Let the accustomed blessing be given. Or let that of Numbers 6 be taken, which the Lord himself appointed, saying: "The Lord bless us and keep us, show us his face and have mercy upon us; the Lord turn his face unto us and give us peace." Or that of Psalm 96 [67]: "God, even our own God, bless us; God bless us, and let all the ends of the earth fear him. Amen."

Note.

- **The postcommunion.** The variable postcommunions (*complenda*) are rejected because "they almost all sound of sacrifice". The two priest's prayers said at the ablutions take their place, read aloud in the collect tone:
    - "What we have taken with our mouth, O Lord, may we receive with a pure mind; and from a temporal gift may it become for us an everlasting remedy";
    - "Thy Body, O Lord, which I have taken, and thy Blood, which I have drunk, cleave unto my inmost parts …", made plural.

  Brandenburg 1540 and Pfalz-Neuburg 1543 kept both in Latin (§7.12.8, §7.14.8). Volprecht (§7.7.2) and Strasbourg (§7.5.1; Moderate Reformed) turned *Quod ore* (What with our mouth) into German.

- ***Benedicamus Domino*** replaces *Ite, missa est*.

- **The blessing.** Luther's use of Numbers 6 is the origin of the Aaronic blessing at the end of the Lutheran Mass.

7.3.6 The *Deutsche Messe* of 1526 (for comparison)

Luther's German Mass (Sehling 1, Nr. 8; doc 3) keeps none of the Canon or of the priest's prayers:

- **In place of the Canon** stands a public paraphrase of the Our Father, with an admonition to the communicants: "After the sermon shall follow a public paraphrase of the Our Father and an admonition to them that will go to the sacrament …".
- **The Verba.** Luther suggested giving the bread straight after the bread-word, "before the cup is blessed", and the cup after the cup-word.
- **The elevation** is kept: "The elevation we will not do away but keep, because it agreeth well with the German Sanctus …".
- **No fraction, no *Pax*.**
- **The thanksgiving** is a new collect, "We give thanks to thee, almighty Lord God, that thou hast refreshed us through this salutary gift …". Bugenhagen's orders (§7.15) and Brandenburg 1540 (§7.12.8) carry it.

This is why most Lutheran orders after 1526 have no Canon remnants. The orders in this file are those that, like the *Formula missae* (Form of the Mass), kept something of the old text.

7.4 Allstedt, Thomas Müntzer, *Deutsch evangelisch Messe*, 1524, and *Ordnung des teutschen ampts*, 1523/24

- **The Mass.** *Deutsch evangelisch messze, etwan durch die Bebstischen pfaffen im latein zu grossem nachteil des Christen glaubens vor ein opffer gehandelt …* (German evangelical Mass, formerly handled by the papist priests in Latin as a sacrifice, to the great harm of the Christian faith …) Sehling 1, Nr. 46, pp. 497–503 (`eko.db` doc 51). It gives five Masses (Advent, Christmas, Passion, Easter, Whitsun) with their propers set to the old chant. The ordinary is printed in full with the first, the Advent Mass, on pp. 500–501. It is given here.
- **The commentary.** *Ordnung und berechnunge des teutschen ampts zu Alstadt*, 1523, printed at Allstedt 1524. Sehling 1, Nr. 47, pp. 504–506 (doc 52). It explains the Mass item by item and gives the rubrics the Mass itself lacks.

Müntzer was no Lutheran but a leader of the Radical Reformation; yet his German Mass is the most conservative in the corpus in wording. It keeps:

- the offertory chant, with the Secret's *Per omnia saecula saeculorum* (World without end);
- the full proper Preface;
- the Roman *Qui pridie* (Who the day before) with *mysterium fidei* (the mystery of faith);
- the end of the embolism, with the fraction (per the *Ordnung* [order]);
- *Pax Domini* (The peace of the Lord).

His wording was taken over in the Lippe Mass (§7.10), the Kiel Low German Mass (§7.11) and, for the Preface dialogue, Calenberg-Göttingen 1542 (§7.13).

7.4.1 Offertory, Preface, Sanctus (Advent)

O Lord, unto thee have I lifted up my soul; O God, my God, in thee I trust, and shall not be put to shame, that mine enemies mock me not; world without end. Amen. The Lord be with you. And with thy spirit. Our hearts on high. We have them unto the Lord. We give thanks unto the Lord our God. It is worthy and it is right. Verily it is meet and right and it is wholesome that we should at all times and in all places give thanks unto thee, O Lord, holy Father, almighty, everlasting God. For thou hast received thy holy manhood of the Virgin Mary by the overshadowing of the Holy Ghost, that she with unblemished chastity brought forth unto the world the everlasting light, Jesus Christ our Lord. Through whom the angels praise thy glory, and the angels in whom thou reignest do thee honour; the mighty angels tremble; and the heavens and the powers of the heavens and the holy seraphim praise thee without ceasing with one accord of joy. Therefore we beseech thee, O Lord, that thou wouldest let our voices be admitted with them, that we may praise thee with true confession without end, saying: Holy, holy, holy, Lord God of Sabaoth. Heaven and earth are filled with thy praise. Hosanna in the highest. Blessed be he that cometh in the name of the Lord. Hosanna in the highest.

Note.

- **The offertory chant.** "O Lord, unto thee have I lifted up my soul …" is the offertory chant of the first Sunday of Advent, *Ad te, Domine, levavi animam meam: Deus meus, in te confido, non erubescam: neque irrideant me inimici mei* (Unto thee, O Lord, have I lifted up my soul: O my God, I trust in thee; let me not be ashamed, neither let mine enemies triumph over me; Ps 25:1–2). The *Ordnung* (order) says "We hold no sacrifice in the secret of God": the offertory prayers are gone, but not the chant.
- **"through all eternity of eternity. Amen."** This is *Per omnia saecula saeculorum. Amen*, the audible end of the silent Secret, which led into the Preface dialogue. The Secret itself is gone; its last words remain. The same place in Lippe (§7.10) has it as the first words of the "Prefatio" (Preface), and Göttingen 1542 (§7.13) has "God be praised from eternity to eternity. Amen."
- **The Preface** is the Preface of the Blessed Virgin, not the Advent or Christmas Preface. Its text is "And on the [feast] of the blessed Mary ever Virgin to praise thee … who conceived thine only-begotten Son by the overshadowing of the Holy Spirit, and, the glory of her virginity remaining, shed forth upon the world the eternal light, Jesus Christ our Lord. Through whom the Angels praise thy majesty, the Dominions adore, the Powers tremble. The heavens and the Virtues of the heavens and the blessed Seraphim celebrate it together with joy".
    - Müntzer takes out the praise of Mary. God himself becomes the subject: "thou [hast] received thy holy humanity …".
    - The Virgin's *virginitatis gloria permanente* (the glory of her virginity remaining) becomes "with unbroken chastity".
    - The ranks of angels are rendered one by one: *Dominationes* (Dominions) "the angels, wherein thou reignest"; *tremunt Potestates* (the Powers tremble) "the mighty angels were astonished".
- **"with true confession"** is *supplici confessione* (with humble confession).

7.4.2 The Verba, the Our Father, the end of the embolism, the Peace, *Agnus Dei*

The day before, when Jesus would suffer, he took the bread into his holy hands, and lifted up his eyes to heaven unto thee, God, his almighty Father, and gave thanks unto thee, and blessed it, and brake it, and gave it to his disciples, saying: Take, and eat thereof. This is my body, which is given for you. In like manner, when they had eaten, he took the cup into his holy and worthy hands, and gave thanks unto thee, and blessed it, and gave it to his disciples, saying: Take, and drink ye all thereof. This is the cup of my blood of the new and everlasting covenant, a mystery of faith, which is shed for you and for many for the forgiveness of sins. As oft as ye do this, ye shall remember me thereby. Therefore let us all pray, as Jesus Christ, the Son of God, hath taught us, saying: Our Father, which art in the heavens, hallowed be thy name, thy kingdom come, thy will be done, as in heaven, so on earth. Give us this day our daily bread, and forgive us our debts, as we forgive our debtors. And lead us not into temptation, but deliver us from evil. Amen. World without end. Amen. The peace of the Lord be alway with you. And with thy spirit. O Lamb of God, which beareth the sin of the world, have mercy upon us. O Lamb of God, which beareth the sin of the world, give us thy peace.

Note.

- **The Verba are the Roman *Qui pridie*, not the Scriptural text.** "One day before, when Jesus would suffer" is *Qui pridie quam pateretur* (Who the day before he suffered). The following are all kept:
    - *in sanctas ac venerabiles manus suas* ("into his holy [worthy] hands");

- *elevatis oculis in caelum ad te Deum Patrem suum omnipotentem* ("lifted up his eyes to heaven unto thee, God his almighty Father");
- *tibi gratias agens* ("gave thanks to thee"), still addressed to the Father in the second person;
- *benedixit* ("blessed it");
- *Accipite et manducate ex hoc omnes* ("eat thereof");
- *novi et aeterni testamenti* ("of the new and eternal covenant");
- ***mysterium fidei*** ("a mystery of the faith");
- *Haec quotiescumque feceritis, in mei memoriam facietis* (As often as ye shall do these things, ye shall do them in remembrance of me).

Only "which is given for you" (Luke 22:19) is added. The *Ordnung* (order; below) has the same text, with crosses at the two blessings.

- **"Therefore let us all pray, as Jesus Christ … hath taught us, saying"** is *Oremus: Praeceptis salutaribus moniti, et divina institutione formati, audemus dicere* (Let us pray: Admonished by saving precepts and formed by divine institution, we make bold to say).
- **"Through all eternity of eternity. Amen."** after the Our Father is *Per omnia saecula saeculorum. Amen* (World without end. Amen), the sung ending of the embolism *Libera nos* (Deliver us). The embolism is gone and its ending stays. The *Ordnung* puts the fraction here (§7.4.3).
- **"The peace of the Lord be always with you. And with thy spirit"** is *Pax Domini sit semper vobiscum. Et cum spiritu tuo* (The peace of the Lord be always with you. And with thy spirit), with the Roman response.
- **The *Agnus Dei*** is printed twice in the Mass and three times in the *Ordnung*.

7.4.3 The Allstedt *Ordnung* on the Sacrament: Verba, elevation, fraction

Ninthly: Then is sung the form of the consecration, or of the supper, in the tone of the Preface, according to these words following: The day before, when Jesus would suffer, he took the bread into his holy and worthy hands, and lifted up his eyes to heaven unto thee, God, his almighty Father, gave thanks unto thee, and blessed ✠ it, and brake it, and gave it to his disciples, saying: Take, and eat ye all thereof. *Lifting it up with his hand he saith:* This is my body, which is given for you. *The minister turning, and taking the cup, saith before the people:* In like manner, when they had eaten, he took the cup into his holy and worthy hands, and gave thanks unto thee, and blessed ✠ it, and gave it to his disciples, saying: This is the cup of my blood, of the new and everlasting testament, a mystery of faith, which is shed for you and for many for the forgiveness of sins. *Turning again to the altar he saith:* As oft and often as ye do this, ye shall remember me thereby, etc. Tenthly. Soon after the elevation one singeth straightway in the same tone thus: Therefore let us all pray, as Jesus Christ, the true Son of God, hath taught us, saying: Our Father, which art in the heavens, etc.; and all the people sing thereupon: Amen. Thereafter it becometh still a little while, to take breath, during which time the priest divideth the sacrament for the sake of the communicants, and singeth: World without end. Then the common people answer: Amen. The priest again: The peace of the Lord be alway with you. Then the people answer: And with thy spirit. Soon after this, that a mystery of God, the death and resurrection of Christ, may be considered, and to explain the same further, all the people sing the witness of John the Baptist of Christ three times: O Lamb of God, which takest away the sin of the world, etc.; thereto is sung out of the Gospel, Luke 17: Have mercy upon us; and at the last: Give us thy peace. […] Upon such faith the people are then given the most worthy sacrament under the Agnus Dei, without the popish hypocritical confession.

Note.

- **The fraction.** "during which time the priest, for the communicants' sake, divideth the sacrament and singeth: Through all eternity of eternity". This is exactly the Roman place and manner: the priest broke the host during the last words of the embolism and sang *Per omnia saecula saeculorum* (World without end) over the broken host before the *Pax*.
  - **The reason is new.** The priest breaks "for the communicants' sake", for the sake of the communicants, to share the bread. It is not a rite of the Mass for its own sake.
  - **No commixture** is mentioned.
  - Luther had forbidden the fraction in the same year (§7.3.3).
- **"termung".** This is Müntzer's word for the consecration ("the words of the termung"; "the consecration a termung, which happeneth not by one alone but by the whole assembled congregation"). Sehling does not gloss it.

- **The elevation.** The bread is elevated at the bread-word ("Elevando manu"). The cup is shown to the people ("coram vulgo").
- **Communion** is given during the *Agnus Dei* (Lamb of God), "without the papist, hypocritical confession". The *Ordnung* (order) adds that after communion "one giveth thanks to God over the people and blesseth the Lord etc.": the postcommunion and the *Benedicamus* (§7.4.4).

7.4.4 Postcommunion and *Benedicamus* (Advent Mass)

O Lord God, stand hard by us, that we may make renunciation of our grievous vices, forasmuch as we have bound ourselves irrevocably unto thee through the spirit of Christ, thy Son, by this holy sign of his tender flesh and precious blood; who with thee liveth and reigneth in the unity of the Holy Ghost, etc. Let us bless the Lord. Thanks be to God for ever.

Note.

- **The postcommunion.** It is not a Roman text. The sacrament as a "holy sign" of a covenant bond fits Müntzer's teaching. "Tender flesh and precious blood" are the vocabulary of late-medieval eucharistic devotion (compare Kantz's "tender body and rose-coloured blood", §7.2.1).
- ***Benedicamus Domino / Deo gratias*** replaces *Ite, missa est* (Go, it is the dismissal), as in the *Formula missae* (Form of the Mass).
- **The Whitsun postcommunion.** The other Masses have their own postcommunions. The Whitsun one ("O Lord, grant us the grace of the Holy Ghost, that the dew of thy goodness may make the ground of our hearts fruitful by its sprinkling", Sehling 1, 504) renders the Roman Whitsun postcommunion *Sancti Spiritus, Domine, corda nostra mundet infusio: et sui roris intima aspersione fecundet* (May the infusion of the Holy Spirit, O Lord, cleanse our hearts, and make them fruitful by the inward sprinkling of his dew). Calenberg-Göttingen 1542 took it over (§7.13.4).

7.5 Strasbourg, the early German Masses, 1524–1525

Sehling 20, Straßburg, Nr. 3 "Die frühen Agenden" (The early agendas), pp. 120–162 (`eko.db` doc 1279). These are Moderate Reformed orders: Strasbourg's Reformation under Bucer and Capito stood between Wittenberg and Zurich until the Interim. Sehling prints six forms:

	Form	Pages
a	Theobald (Diebold) Schwarz's manuscript agenda, "Anfang der evangelischen meß", 1524	120–123
b	*Teutsche Meß und Tauff, wie sye yetzund zu Straßburg gehalten werden*, 1524	130–134
c	*Ordenung und inhalt Teutscher Mess*, Augsburg reprint, 1524	135
d	*Teutsch Kirchenampt mit lobgsengen*, 1524/25	136–141
e	*Ordnung des Herren Nachtmal, so man die mesß nennet*, 1525	142–150
f	*Straßburger kirchen ampt*, 1525	151–162

The Worms Mass (§7.6) is the Strasbourg Mass of 1524 in use at Worms. Its Canon prayers (*Te igitur* to *Supplices*) are not in Schwarz's text. A later hand added one of them, the *Unde et memores* (Wherefore, mindful), to the manuscript, along with *mysterium fidei* (the mystery of faith; noted in §7.5.1). Döber took his optional intercession from Strasbourg (§7.8.11).

Across these six forms the Canon is replaced step by step:

- **a–d:** a single intercession in the place of *Te igitur*, with the Verba and a short prayer after the elevation.
- **e (1525):** one long prayer "in place of the Canon" after a shortened common Preface and Sanctus. The Verba are read afterwards as a lesson, and there is no elevation.
- **f:** the same prayer, revised, with no Preface or Sanctus at all.

7.5.1 Schwarz's Mass, 1524 (form a)

Turned toward the people let him say: Dear brethren and sisters, pray God the Father, through our Lord Jesus Christ, that he send us the Holy Ghost, the Comforter, that he may make our bodies a living, holy, well-pleasing sacrifice, which is the reasonable service of God that pleaseth God. May this befall us all, Amen. *Toward the people, still standing, let him say:* The Lord be with you. *The Preface* Lift up your hearts. Let us give thanks unto the Lord our God. It becometh us truly, and is meet, right and wholesome, that we should alway and in all places give thanks unto thee, O Lord, holy, almighty Father, everlasting God, who hast wrought our salvation through the wood of the cross, that life might come from thence whence death arose, and that the enemy who by the transgression of the tree had overcome us all in Adam might be vanquished again by the obedience rendered on the tree; through Christ Jesus our Lord, through whose majesty and glory the angels and all the heavenly host praise thee, and together with like exultation extol and magnify thee; with whom we pray thee to receive our voices also, with humble confession, saying: *Sanctus* Sanctus. Holy, holy Lord, God of hosts, the heavens and earth are full of thy glory. Ah, save us in the highest. *Benedictus* Praised be he that cometh in the name of the Lord. Ah, save us in the highest.

Note.

- **The bidding replaces the *Orate fratres*.** The Roman request that "my sacrifice and yours may be acceptable" becomes a prayer for the Spirit, who makes "our bodies" the sacrifice (Rom 12:1). The only sacrifice named is that of the worshippers.
- **The Preface** is the Preface of the Cross (Passiontide): "who didst set the salvation of mankind upon the tree of the Cross, that whence death arose, thence life might rise again, and that he who overcame by the tree might also by the tree be overcome, through Christ our Lord. Through whom the Angels praise thy majesty …". Form b prints further proper Prefaces (Christmas, Epiphany, Easter, Ascension, Whitsun) "for when thou hast read … Eternal God".
- **The Sanctus.** "Ah, make us blessed" and "Ah, bless us" translate *Hosanna*.

Let the hands be washed. Silently. Then standing in the manner of one praying: With hands lifted up, if it please: Almighty, merciful Father, forasmuch as thy Son, our Lord Jesus, hath promised that whatsoever we ask in his name thou wilt grant us; and moreover, forasmuch as thy Spirit also hath commanded that we should pray for our rulers: we pray thee from our hearts that thou wouldest move the minds of the emperor, the princes and lords, and first of all of our lords and superiors of the honourable Council, to the knowledge of thy goodness and of the Gospel; and also that thou wouldest make all peoples subject to thy Son through the Holy Ghost, that they themselves may willingly know, receive and keep his promise. And above all grant unto this congregation that it may increase in the knowledge of the Gospel and of his sweet yoke and easy burden. Forasmuch now, almighty, everlasting God, beloved and merciful Father, — Who on the next day before his passion took the bread into his holy hands, and gave thanks unto thee, God, his heavenly Father, blessed it, brake it, and gave it to his disciples, and said: Take, and eat. This is my body, which shall be given for you. *At the cup:* Likewise after the supper he took the cup into his holy hands, and gave thanks, and said: Take, and drink ye all thereof. This is the cup of my blood, of the new and everlasting testament, which shall be shed for you and many for the forgiveness of sins. *The elevation of the cup:* As oft as ye do this, do it in remembrance of me.

Note.

- **The *lavabo*.** "Let the hands be washed. Silently" keeps the priest's washing of hands from the offertory, moved to after the Sanctus.
- **The posture.** "Levatis … manibus", "per modum orantis" (in the manner of one praying): the priest stands with raised hands, as for the Canon.
- **The intercession replaces *Te igitur*.** It stands where *Te igitur* (Thee therefore) stood, and like *Te igitur* it prays for the Church and its rulers, with emperor and council in place of pope and bishop.
    - It breaks off at "Forasmuch now, almighty, eternal God, beloved and merciful Father," and the relative "Who" of *Qui pridie* (Who the day before) follows. The sentence is left unfinished in the manuscript. A second hand added a continuation (Sehling's apparatus q, later struck out): "O most gracious Father, thine only Son … which thou hast given to the world through Christ Jesus our Lord." This is the germ of the long 1525 prayer (§7.5.2).
    - Döber prints the same intercession as an option "after the Preface or before the Sanctus" (§7.8.11). Form d calls it "Almighty, merciful Father, forasmuch as thy Son …".
- ***Qui pridie*** keeps "on the next day before his suffering" (*pridie quam pateretur*), "blessed it" (*benedixit*) and *novi et aeterni testamenti* (of the new and eternal testament).
    - It adds "which shall be given for you" (1 Cor 11:24).
    - A later hand adds after the cup-word "The mystery of the faith", *mysterium fidei* (the mystery of faith).
    - The bread is not elevated. The cup is elevated at *Haec quotiescumque* (As often as).

- **Form b's rubrics.** Form b marks this passage "Beginning of the right, true Mass" and, after it, "End of the Mass or of the Supper of Christ, for the words that go before and after are all brought in to move and refresh faith, and not as the chief part of the Mass". That is: only the Verba are the Mass. All that stands before and after is there to move and refresh faith, and may be changed or left out.

After the elevation How great is thy goodness, that without any merit of ours thou hast not only forgiven us our sins, but hast left us for an assurance the body and blood of our Lord Jesus Christ under the bread and wine; as thou hast alway witnessed all other promises besides with outward signs. Therefore have we now great and irresistible assurance of thy grace, and know that we are thy children, thine heirs and joint-heirs with Christ, and may freely pray, as thine only-begotten Son hath taught us, and say: Our Father, which art in the heavens, hallowed be thy name. Thy kingdom come. Thy will be done, as in heaven, so on earth. Give us this day our daily bread. And forgive us our debts, even as we forgive our debtors. And lead us not into temptation, but deliver us from evil, Amen. Lord, deliver us from all enemies visible and invisible, from the devil, the world, and from our own flesh; through Christ Jesus our Lord, Amen. *Agnus Dei* (Lamb of God) Thou Lamb of God, that takest away the sin of the world, have mercy upon us. Thou Lamb of God, grant us peace.

Note.

- **"Post elevationem" (After the elevation).** The prayer stands where *Unde et memores* (Wherefore, mindful) stood, after the consecration. It thanks God for the body and blood left "under the bread and wine" as a pledge, and leads into the Our Father like *Praeceptis salutaribus* (Taught by saving precepts; "may freely pray" is *audemus dicere* [we make bold to say]).
- **The later hand at Strasbourg.** At this point it wrote into the margin the German *Unde et memores* that Worms prints: "Therefore, Lord, we thy servants, considering the … passion and death of the same thy Son, his resurrection from hell and also the glorious ascension into the heavens of thy divine majesty, offer therewith our humble prayer, whereon thou mayest look with gracious, cheerful eyes …" (compare §7.6.8).
  - It also corrected "the body and blood" to "the remembrance of the body and blood", and "under" to "in".
  - It added the doxology to the Our Father.
- **The embolism.** "Lord, deliver us from all visible and invisible enemies …" is the embolism reduced to one line. Döber has the same line (§7.8.5), and Sehling calls it there "remnant of the embolism". There is no fraction.

A short exhortation to the people. The communion Let us pray: Lord Jesu Christ, thou Son of the living God, who by the Father's will and the working of the Holy Ghost hast through thy death brought the world to life: deliver us by this thy holy body and blood from all our iniquities and wickednesses, and grant that we may alway obey thy commandments, and never for ever be separated from thee, Amen. *The complenda* Let us pray: What we have taken to us with the mouth, grant us, Lord, that we may receive the same with a pure mind, and that of the temporal gift there may be made unto us an everlasting medicine; through Christ Jesus our Lord, Amen. *Or some other which seemeth Christian. To the people:* The Lord be with you. *The blessing* The blessing of God, the Father ✠ and the Son ✠ and the Holy Ghost ✠, be with us and remain alway, Amen.

Note.

- ***Fili Dei vivi*** is said aloud as the prayer of all ("Let us pray") before the communion. Form b adds the rubric "Here both sacraments, the body and blood of the Lord under bread and wine, are distributed … to the people". Döber (§7.8.8) and the Kiel Mass (§7.11) have the same German text, said by the people after the priest.
- **The *complenda*** is *Quod ore sumpsimus* (What we have taken with our mouth) in full. It is the "complenda" (completion) Luther had recommended (§7.3.5).
- **The blessing** keeps three crosses.
- **Form d** (the *Kirchenampt* [Church office]) adds after the *Agnus* a rubric for the exhortation: "wherein they press only on the fruitful remembrance and wholesome proclamation of the death of Christ". At the distribution the priest says "only the words of the Supper". Luther's "Gott sei gelobet" (God be praised) follows as the communion hymn, then the Aaronic blessing. The *complenda* is gone.

7.5.2 The *Ordnung des Herren Nachtmal*, 1525 (form e): the prayer "in place of the Canon"

Thereafter the minister prepareth the chalice, and then speaketh to the people: Dear brethren and sisters, pray ye all God our Father that he send us his Holy Ghost, who may teach us to offer up the sacrifices of God, a broken spirit and a contrite heart; and that we give our bodies a sacrifice, living, holy and well-pleasing unto him, which is our reasonable service; that we may also

offer up thanks and praise unto God, and he may show us his salvation. The Lord will hear you all. So let us now lift up our hearts unto the Lord, and give thanks unto him, our Lord and God. For it is indeed right, meet and wholesome that we should at all times and in all places give praise and thanks unto thee, holy Lord, almighty Father, everlasting God, and that through Jesus Christ our Saviour, through whom the angels also praise thee and all the heavenly powers magnify thee; with whom we also pray and beseech thee that thou wouldest admit our voices also, who with humble confession say: *Sanctus* Holy, holy, holy art thou, the Lord and God of hosts; full are heaven and earth of thy glory. Hosanna, help us, most Highest. Blessed art thou also, that comest in the name of the Lord, a son of David. Hosanna, ah help us, most Highest, that thy kingdom may increase and be strengthened.

Note.

- **The bidding** is expanded with Ps 51:17 ("the sacrifices of God, a broken spirit") and Heb 13:15 ("give thanks and offer up praise"). The *Orate fratres* has become a prayer to offer the sacrifices Scripture allows.
- **The Preface** is the common Preface, reduced to its frame. The dialogue is folded into one sentence spoken by the minister.

And instead of the Canon the following prayer is used: Almighty God, and Father of our Saviour Jesus Christ, who by the same thy most dear Son, our Lord, hast promised that whatsoever we ask thee in his name thou wilt grant us, and hast moreover by thy Holy Ghost commanded us to pray for all rulers and all men: we beseech thee from our hearts, through the same thy most dear Son, our Saviour, that thou wouldest enlighten the heart of all princes and lords, and specially of our rulers, the honourable Council, with the knowledge of thy holy Gospel, that they may acknowledge thee for their right and only Sovereign, and govern us, the work of thy hands and the sheep of thy pasture, according to thy will and pleasure. And vouchsafe unto all men to come to the knowledge of thy truth; and unto this thy congregation, here present and gathered in thy name, thy Holy Ghost, the Comforter, who writeth thy law in our hearts, that our inborn blindness and folly may be taken away, whereby we not only cannot know our sin and evil, but are well pleased with ourselves therein. Therefore, O merciful God, most dear, make our sin alive in us by thy Holy Ghost, that we may feel it and know its vileness and shame; and that thence, seeing we find in ourselves nothing but sin, death and hell, we may obtain a true hunger and thirst for thy grace and mercy, that we may yet in part consider, receive with rightly-formed faith, and praise with everlasting thankfulness thy overflowing, unmeasurable grace and goodness, which thou hast shown us in this, that thou wouldest have thine only-begotten Son become man (that is, like unto us poor sinners), suffer and die for us, and by his death redeem us from sin, death and hell. Grant us now therefore, heavenly Father, that we may never let the wholesome remembrance of this death, whereby we are redeemed from all evil unto everlasting life, go out of our hearts; that we also with him, our Saviour, may die unto sin and live unto righteousness, in all patience and love toward our neighbour, with joyful watching, awaiting the blessed hope and coming of the same our dear Lord and Redeemer. And grant that we may at this time also keep his holy Supper unto such wholesome and needful remembrance with such a heart that we seek not things temporal nor our own, but the rising of thy kingdom, and desire to be loosed from sin and furthered unto all godliness; that none of us become guilty of the body or the blood of our Saviour Jesus Christ, nor eat judgement and damnation to himself, if he here confess himself to be a member of Christ, and believe that alone by the sacrifice which he once offered up for us on the cross unto thee, O Father, his body and blood, and yet had not such faith as is active through love toward all, and so made a mockery with the Supper of our Lord; but that we all herewith in true faith may consider and receive his death suffered for us; that we may surely believe that thou wilt be our gracious and merciful Father, who hast taken us to be children and heirs, to be conformed to thy most dear and first-begotten Son Jesus Christ, although we still live here as in sins, so also in continual tribulation; that we also may all hold one another as true brethren and thy children, ready to do good to please thee, also to take up thy rod and trial alway with all patience, and so to wait altogether willingly for the time when thou shalt deliver us from the body of sin. This faith, hope and love vouchsafe, heavenly Father, to strengthen and establish in us, that we may call and pray unto thee in truth and in right spirit, as our only Master hath taught us, and say: Our Father, which art in heaven, hallowed be thy name. […] For thine is the kingdom, and the power, and the glory, for ever, Amen.

Note.

- **The rubric.** "And instead of the Canon one useth this following prayer". The heading says outright what the prayer is for.
- **How it grows out of Schwarz.** It begins with Schwarz's *Te igitur* (Thee therefore) substitute (§7.5.1) and continues with the second hand's addition there. It runs into the Our Father, as Schwarz's *Post elevationem* (After the elevation) did, but without Verba between.
- **Canon themes, recast:**
    - intercession for rulers and "this thy congregation, here present" (*Te igitur*, *Memento … omnium circumstantium*);

    - the remembrance of the Son's death, resurrection and coming ("the wholesome remembrance … of this death", "awaiting … the coming"), which does the work of the *anamnesis* of *Unde et memores* (Wherefore, mindful);
    - a petition for a fruitful communion (*Supplices … ut quotquot … sumpserimus*, We humbly beseech thee … that as many of us as … shall receive), turned into a warning against eating judgement (1 Cor 11:27–29).
- **The one sacrifice.** The only sacrifice named is Christ's own, "as he once for all offered up to thee, O Father, his body and blood for us on the cross" (Heb 9:28; 10:14). Here the critique the Brandenburg-Nürnberg order would make in 1533 is already in the prayer itself (see Appendix 7.A).
- **No Verba.** This prayer is not followed by the Verba but by the Our Father. The Verba come after an admonition (below), read as a lesson from 1 Cor 11. There is no elevation.

After this prayer the minister exhorteth the people to consider the passion of the Lord, according to the grace given, and commonly concludeth it thus: Let us now hear how the Lord ordained his Supper, and what he hath commanded to be done. *And he readeth the words of the Supper out of the first Epistle of Paul to the Corinthians, the eleventh chapter, with earnest words, as here followeth:* The Lord Jesus, in the night in which he was betrayed, took the bread, and when he had given thanks, he brake it, and gave it to his disciples, and said: Take, and eat. This is my body, which is given for you. This do in remembrance of me. After the same manner also the cup, when they had supped at evening, and said: This is the cup, the new testament in my blood, which is shed for you and for many for the loosing of sin. This do, as oft as ye drink it, in remembrance of me. *Thereafter the minister saith to the people:* Come ye now hither, that will with me keep and receive the Supper of the Lord. May he make you meet thereto, and grant you to consider his death with right faith and to show it forth with true thankfulness. *And in the giving of the bread and of the cup of the Lord he saith thus:* Remember, believe, and show forth that Christ died for you.

Note.

- **The *Pax*.** "Come ye now hither …" takes the place of the *Pax* and the invitation to communion.
- **"Remember, believe, proclaim …"** replaces the *custodiat* (preserve). Form f keeps it.

7.5.3 *Straßburger kirchen ampt*, 1525 (form f)

The last form drops the Preface and Sanctus. After the Creed comes an explanatory rubric and a still longer bidding:

After the ending of the Creed, that the unchristian sacrificial Masses may not be a stumbling-block to the people, and that it may be understood how Christ was once offered for us for the full satisfaction of our sins, the pastor sometimes speaketh thus: Dear brethren and sisters, pray God the Father, through our Lord Jesus Christ, who was given into death for the redemption of our souls, that he send us the Holy Ghost, who may teach us to offer up, not Christ, who offered himself once for us and can be offered by no man, but the true sacrifices well-pleasing to God, as a broken spirit, a contrite heart; and that we yield our bodies a sacrifice, living, holy and well-pleasing unto him, which is our reasonable service, wherein we offer unto God honour, praise and thanksgiving. The Lord hear you and show you his salvation, Amen.

Note.

- **The last trace of the *Orate fratres*.** It is now a polemic against the Mass-sacrifice. Sehling refers to Bucer's argument from Hebrews in the same years.
- **What follows.** "The Lord be with you. Let us pray:" introduces the revised prayer of form e, "Almighty, merciful God and Father …". It is shorter on the magistrates and longer on the unity of the members of Christ's body ("whose members we all are … incorporated through the joints of love, with the bond of peace").
- **The Supper itself.** The Our Father; an exhortation (a specimen from St. Peter the Younger, Reminiscere 1525, is printed); the Verba from 1 Cor 11; the invitation; the distribution with "Remember, believe and proclaim …".
- **The end of the Canon at Strasbourg.** Nothing of the Roman Canon is left but its intercession and its remembrance, both prayed in the congregation's own words.

7.6 Worms, *Deutsche Messe*, 1524

Form und Ordenung der Evangelischen deutschen Messen, wie sie zu Worms gehalten wird. (Form and order of the evangelical German Mass, as it is held at Worms.) Sehling 19, III, Nr. 1, pp. 124–129. Like its Strasbourg original, it is a Moderate Reformed order.

The preface says this Mass is kept "at Strasbourg and Worms". This is the Strasbourg German Mass of 1524 (§7.5) in use at Worms, with the Canon prayers that Schwarz's Strasbourg manuscript lacks.

It keeps more of the Canon than any other order in the corpus. The Canon runs in its proper order from *Te igitur* (Thee therefore) to *Supplices te rogamus* (We humbly beseech thee), each prayer translated and trimmed. There are three kinds of change:

- **Sacrificial nouns replaced.**
  - *haec dona, haec munera, haec sancta sacrificia illibata* (these gifts, these presents, these holy unspotted sacrifices) becomes "this thy bread and wine";
  - *hostiam puram* (a pure victim) becomes "our humble prayer";
  - *hanc oblationem* (this oblation) becomes "us and … our prayer".
- **Office-holders replaced.** Pope and bishop give way to emperor, king and rulers.
- **Saints dropped.** The saints, the dead and the doxology *Per ipsum* (Through him) are gone.

The Canon still stands between the Sanctus and the Our Father, where it belongs.

7.6.1 Preparation of the chalice (*Orate fratres*)

The preparing of the cup. Dear brethren and sisters, pray God that my prayer and yours may be acceptable. The Lord be with you. *Answer:* And with thy spirit.

Note. This is "Pray, brethren, that my sacrifice and yours may be acceptable to God the Father almighty", with *sacrificium* (sacrifice) replaced by *gebet* (prayer). It follows the Creed directly. There is no offertory chant and there are no offertory prayers.

7.6.2 Preface and Sanctus

The Preface. Lift up your hearts unto God. *Answer:* We lift them up unto God. Let us give thanks unto God our Lord. *Answer:* It is meet and right. Yea, verily it is meet and right, and also wholesome, that we should in all places and at all times give thanks unto thee, holy Father, almighty, everlasting God, through Christ our Lord: through whom all the angels and the heavenly powers worship, honour and praise thy glorious majesty; with the same we beseech thee that thou wouldest admit and accept our voice, that we also may praise thee and say without end: Holy, holy, holy, Lord God of Sabaoth; full are heaven and earth of thy glory. Hosanna in the highest. Bless ✠ ed be he that cometh in the name of the Lord. Prosperity and salvation in the highest.

Note. This is the common Preface. "Through whom the Angels praise thy majesty, the Dominions adore, the Powers tremble … with whom we pray thee that thou wouldest bid our voices also to be admitted" is condensed. The second *Hosanna* is translated as "prosperity and salvation" (prosperity and salvation). The sign of the cross at *Benedictus* is kept.

7.6.3 *Te igitur*

Wherefore, most gracious Father, we humbly pray and desire through Jesus Christ thy Son our Lord, that thou wouldest look upon, bless and ble ✠ ss this thy bread and wine; and also graciously accept our prayer, which we make in the first place for thy holy Christian Church, and give peace to the same, keep, unite and govern it throughout the whole compass of the world, with the emperor, the king and all our rulers, together with all thy faithful Christians.

Note. Compare "Therefore, most merciful Father, we humbly pray and beseech thee, through Jesus Christ thy Son our Lord, that thou wouldest accept and bless these gifts, these presents, these holy unspotted sacrifices, which in the first place we offer thee for thy holy catholic Church, which vouchsafe to keep in peace, to guard, to unite and to govern throughout the whole world, together with thy servant N. our Pope and N. our Bishop, and all the orthodox …"

- **Gifts and offering.** The gifts become "this thy bread and wine". "which we offer thee" becomes the prayer "which we … make".
- **Office-holders.** Pope and bishop give way to emperor, king and "all our rulers".
- **Verbs for the Church.** The four verbs for the Church (*pacificare, custodire, adunare, regere*: to keep in peace, to guard, to unite, to govern) are kept exactly.
- **Blessing.** *Accepta habeas et benedicas* (that thou wouldest accept and bless) is translated twice over ("bless and bene ✠ dict"), as a bless-and-bless doublet.

7.6.4 *Memento* of the living, with the end of *Communicantes*

O Lord, remember all thy servants and handmaidens, and all that stand round about, whose faith and devotion is known unto thee, for whose health of soul and body we pray thee; that we all may be preserved by the help of thy protection; through Jesus Christ our Lord.

Note. This is "Remember, O Lord, thy servants and handmaids N. and N., and all here standing round, whose faith is known to thee and whose devotion is manifest".

- **Offering removed.** "For whom we offer unto thee, or who offer unto thee, this sacrifice of praise" becomes "for … we pray thee".
- **Ending borrowed from *Communicantes*.** The ending "that we all may be preserved through the help of thy defence" is the last clause of *Communicantes* (In communion): *ut in omnibus protectionis tuae muniamur auxilio* (that in all things we may be defended by the help of thy protection).
- **Saints dropped.** The list of saints between these two points is gone.

7.6.5 *Hanc igitur*

Wherefore we pray: O Lord, vouchsafe graciously to take unto thee us and all our prayer, and to order all our days in thy peace, to deliver us from eternal damnation, and to number us among the flocks of thine elect; through Christ our Lord. Amen.

Note. This is "This oblation therefore of our service … we beseech thee, O Lord, graciously to accept, and to order our days in thy peace, and to command us to be delivered from eternal damnation and to be numbered in the flock of thine elect". "*Oblationem*" (oblation) becomes "us and all our prayer".

The same words, "deliver from everlasting damnation", are what the 1533/1543 critique singles out as sacrificial (Appendix 7.A).

7.6.6 *Quam oblationem*

O most gracious Father, merciful, everlasting God, help and grant that this bread and the wine may become and be unto us the true body and the innocent blood of thy most dearly beloved Son, our Lord Jesus Christ.

Note. This is "Which oblation do thou, O God, vouchsafe, we beseech thee, in all things to make blessed, approved, ratified, reasonable and acceptable, that it may become for us the Body and Blood of thy most beloved Son our Lord Jesus Christ".

"May it become and be for us" renders *nobis … fiat* (that for us … it may become) exactly. The five adjectives of offering are dropped.

7.6.7 *Qui pridie*, *Simili modo*, *Haec quotiescumque*

Who, on the day before he suffered, took the bread, gave thanks, bless ✠ ed and brake the bread, and gave it to his disciples, saying: Take and eat, this is my body, which is given for you. *The elevation of the Sacrament.* Likewise after the supper he took the cup, gave thanks, bless ✠ ed, and gave it to his disciples, and said: Take, drink ye all thereof; this is the cup of the new and everlasting testament in my blood, which is shed for you and for many for the remission of sins. This, as oft as ye do it, do it in remembrance of me. *The elevation of the cup.*

Note. The Verba keep the Roman Canon's frame:

- "on the day before he suffered" renders *Qui pridie quam pateretur* (Who the day before he suffered);
- "of the new and eternal testament" renders *novi et aeterni testamenti* (of the new and eternal testament);
- "This, as often as ye do it" renders *Haec quotiescumque feceritis* (As often as ye shall do these things).

Two things are dropped: *elevatis oculis in caelum* and *mysterium fidei* (the mystery of faith). "Which is given for you", from Luke and Paul, is added to the bread word.

7.6.8 *Unde et memores* and *Supra quae*

Wherefore, O Lord, we thy servants, considering the passion and death of the same thy Son our Lord Jesus Christ, his resurrection from hell, and also his glorious ascension into the heavens, do therewith offer unto thy divine majesty our humble prayer; whereupon thou wouldest look with a gracious and kindly countenance, and let it be well-pleasing unto thee; through Jesus Christ our Lord.

Note. This is "Wherefore, O Lord, we thy servants … mindful of the blessed passion of the same Christ thy Son our Lord, and also of his resurrection from hell, and of his glorious ascension into heaven, offer unto thy excellent majesty, of thy gifts and bounties, a pure victim …", joined to "Upon which vouchsafe to look with a propitious and serene countenance, and to accept them …".

- **What is offered.** The Canon's *offerimus* is kept ("anbieten"), but what is offered is "our humble prayer", not the *hostia* (victim).
- **Literal rendering.** "Resurrection from hell" renders *ab inferis resurrectionis* (of the resurrection from hell) literally.
- **Types dropped.** The Old Testament types (Abel, Abraham, Melchizedek) are gone.

7.6.9 *Supplices te rogamus*

Almighty God, we humbly beseech thee, grant that our prayer and desire may be brought upon the highest altar before the face of thy divine majesty; that we all, who from this most holy supper receive the body, flesh and blood of thy Son, may be filled with all divine blessing and grace. Through the same Jesus Christ our Lord. Amen.

Note. This is "We humbly beseech thee, almighty God, command these to be carried by the hands of thy holy Angel to thine altar on high, in the sight of thy divine majesty; that as many of us as, by this partaking of the altar, shall receive the most holy Body and Blood of thy Son, may be filled with all heavenly benediction and grace. Through the same Christ …"

- **What is carried up.** "*Haec*" (these; the gifts) becomes "our prayer and desire".
- **The angel.** The angel who carries them is dropped.
- **The altar.** *Ex hac altaris participatione* (by this partaking of the altar) becomes "of this most holy Supper".

7.6.10 Our Father, with the conclusion of the embolism

Let us pray. Out of the admonition of the blessed commandments, and by divine ordinance instructed, we are bold to say: Our Father, which art in the heavens, etc. Through Jesus Christ our Lord, thy Son, who with thee and the Holy Ghost, one true God, liveth and reigneth. Amen.

Note. The introduction to the Our Father is *Praeceptis salutaribus moniti, et divina institutione formati, audemus dicere* (Admonished by saving precepts and formed by divine institution, we make bold to say).

The doxology after it is the ending of the embolism, "Through the same Jesus Christ our Lord, thy Son, who liveth and reigneth with thee in the unity of the Holy Spirit, God". The body of the embolism ("Deliver us, we beseech thee, O Lord, from all evils …", with its saints) is dropped. Only its conclusion remains.

7.6.11 Fraction forbidden; the Peace as absolution

The priest may not break the host, nor let it fall into the cup. The peace of the Lord be alway with you. *This is the right evangelical absolution, which proclaimeth unto the faithful the remission of sin, the only and most worthy preparation for the receiving of the body and blood of Christ. It may well be spoken by the priest turned toward the people.*

Note. The fraction and the commixture (*Haec commixtio …*) are forbidden. Sehling compares Luther's *Formula missae* (Form of the Mass). *Pax Domini sit semper vobiscum* (The peace of the Lord be always with you) is kept, and the rubric explains it as a public absolution.

7.6.12 *Agnus Dei* and communion

Agnus Dei. Thou little Lamb of God, that takest away the sin of the world, have mercy upon us. And grant us peace. *Here let the priest distribute the body and blood to them that desire it. He himself shall not partake of it, unless he have a special hunger thereto.* Behold, dearly beloved, this is verily the holy body of our Lord Jesus Christ, who hath suffered for you the bitter death. Take and eat it, that it may feed, nourish and preserve you unto everlasting life. The body of the Lord Jesus Christ preserve thy soul unto everlasting life. *The priest taketh the cup and saith:* Let us also drink the cup of salvation and call upon the name of the

Lord. Behold, this is verily the dear treasure of the precious blood of our Lord Jesus Christ, wherewith ye are bought. Take and divide it among yourselves, unto the washing away of your sins. Amen. The blood of our Lord Jesus Christ preserve thy soul and my soul unto everlasting life.

Note.

- **Communion formulas.** "The body … preserve thy soul unto everlasting life" is *Corpus Domini nostri Iesu Christi custodiat animam tuam in vitam aeternam* (The body of our Lord Jesus Christ preserve thy soul unto everlasting life). The cup formula is *Sanguis Domini nostri …* (The blood of our Lord …) in the same way.
- **The priest's cup verse.** "Let us also drink the cup of salvation" is the priest's *Calicem salutaris accipiam, et nomen Domini invocabo* (I will take the cup of salvation, and call upon the name of the Lord; Ps 116:13), put into the plural.
- **"Behold".** Each "Behold" (*Ecce*) introduces a showing of the element to the people.
- **"Divide it among you".** This is Luke 22:17.
- **The priest's own communion.** The priest communicates only "if he have a special hunger thereto".

7.6.13 Postcommunion, *Benedicamus*, blessing, *Nunc dimittis*

The Lord be with you. *Answer:* And with thy spirit. *Let us pray:* O Lord Jesus Christ, may thy most holy body which we have partaken, and thy innocent blood which we have drunk, be unto us neither unto damnation nor unto judgement, but, according to thy goodness, unto a defence and medicine of the soul and of the body, a furtherance unto everlasting life; who livest and reignest for ever. Amen. The Lord be with you. *Answer:* And with thy spirit. Let us bless God. Thanks, praise, honour and glory be to God through Christ our Lord. Amen. *The Blessing:* The blessing of Almighty God, Father, Son and Holy Ghost, be with you and remain alway with you. Amen. *Nunc dimittis:* O Lord, let thy servant depart in peace according to thy word; for our eyes have seen thy salvation, which thou hast prepared before the face of all peoples, the light to lighten the Gentiles and to be the glory of thy people Israel. To thee be praise, honour and thanks, blessed, holy Trinity, God Father, Son and Holy Ghost. Amen.

Note.

- **The postcommunion.** It joins two of the priest's communion prayers. The first is "Let the receiving of thy Body, O Lord Jesus Christ … not turn to my judgement and condemnation, but through thy goodness profit me for a defence of mind and body and for a healing remedy". The second is *Corpus tuum, Domine, quod sumpsi, et Sanguis, quem potavi …* (Thy Body, O Lord, which I have taken, and thy Blood, which I have drunk …). Both are made into a public collect.
- **The dismissal.** "Let us bless God" is *Benedicamus Domino* (Let us bless the Lord), and the response is an expanded *Deo gratias*.
- **The blessing.** It is *Benedicat vos omnipotens Deus, Pater et Filius et Spiritus Sanctus* (May almighty God bless you, the Father and the Son and the Holy Ghost).

7.7 Nürnberg, 1524–1525: the parish churches, Volprecht, and the *Form und Ordnung*

Three Nürnberg orders sit alongside Döber's Mass (§7.8):

Order	Sehling	eko.db doc	Pages
Gottesdienstordnung der Pfarrkirchen (St. Sebald, St. Lorenz), June 1524, Latin	11, I.5	249	46–47
Deutsche Messe des Priors Volprecht (Augustinians), 1524	11, I.3	247	41–42
Form und Ordnung einer Christlichen Messe, 1525	11, I.7	251	57

The parish order is Latin and follows the *Formula missae* (Form of the Mass) closely. Volprecht's German Mass is the most conservative in the corpus after Worms (Moderate Reformed). It keeps all three of the priest's prayers before communion and both ablution prayers, translated.

7.7.1 The parish churches, 1524 (Latin)

The Creed ended, the offertory and the lesser canon being omitted, the celebrant beginneth: The Lord be with you. Lift up your hearts. Let us give thanks unto the Lord our God. It is very meet and right, fitting and wholesome, that we should at all times and

in all places give thanks unto thee, O Lord, holy Father, almighty, everlasting God, through Christ our Lord. *Here the Preface endeth. Choir:* Holy, holy. *But the celebrant addeth, reading:* Who the day before he suffered took bread into his holy and venerable hands, and with eyes lifted up to heaven unto thee, God the almighty Father, giving thanks unto thee, blesseth, brake, gave to his disciples, saying: Take and eat ye all of this! For this is my body. *The bread is elevated.* In like manner, after they had supped, taking also this excellent cup into his holy and venerable hands, again giving thanks unto thee, he blessed, gave to his disciples, saying: Take and drink ye all of it! For this is the cup of my blood, of the new and everlasting testament, the mystery of faith, which shall be shed for us and for many unto the remission of sins. *The cup is elevated. The Hosanna in excelsis being ended, the celebrant beginneth,* Let us pray: Taught by wholesome precepts, etc.: Our Father, which art in, etc. *After this the people who are to receive the sacrament are admonished in these words:* [...] *Then the celebrant addeth:* The peace of the Lord be alway with you. *The choir answereth. Then let the people begin to be communicated, the officiant offering the bread and the minister the cup. During the communion the choir singeth the Agnus Dei and the communion. The sacrament having been administered more slowly or more quickly according to the number of persons communicating, if anything remaineth it is consumed by the celebrant and the ministers. Lastly let the office be concluded with the prayer which they call the complenda.*

Note.

- **"offertorio ac canone minore omissis" (the offertory and the lesser canon being omitted).** Sehling explains that the offertory part of the Mass was often called the *canon minor*, the Canon proper being the *canon maior* (greater canon). Both are left out.
- **The Preface** is cut short at *per Christum Dominum nostrum* (through Christ our Lord), as in the *Formula missae* (Form of the Mass; §7.3.2). But here the Sanctus is sung after it.
- ***Qui pridie*** is the full Roman text, *mysterium fidei* (the mystery of faith) included. It is read quietly ("legendo") during the Sanctus and Benedictus, with the two elevations. Sehling (note 17) reads the rubric so: in June 1524 the words were still said in Latin and quietly, as the *Formula missae* allowed ("either silently or aloud"). By March 1525 Nürnberg reported that they were sung aloud "in the tone or melody of the Preface", with the Sanctus after them.
  - The print reads "pro nobis" (for us), where the Roman text has *pro vobis* (for you).
  - "paterctur" and "cafix" are corrected here.
- **The exhortation** is the Nürnberg one printed at §7.8.7.
- ***Pax Domini*** follows the exhortation, as in Döber.
- **No embolism, no fraction.**
- **The postcommunion.** The *complenda* (completion) is the proper postcommunion of the day. Luther had rejected the variable postcommunions (§7.3.5).

7.7.2 Volprecht, 1524

Here the priest prepareth the chalice. As soon as it is prepared let him say: The Lord be with you! *Answer:* And with thy spirit! *Priest:* Lift up the hearts! *Answer:* We lift them up unto the Lord! *Priest:* Let us give thanks unto God our Lord! *Answer:* That is meet and right. *Preface:* Verily it is meet and right. It is seemly and wholesome that we should always and at all times give thanks, thou holy Lord, almighty Father, everlasting God, through Christ our Lord; who in the night in which he was betrayed took the bread, gave thanks unto God his heavenly Father, brake it, and gave it to his disciples, saying: Come and eat! This is my body, which is given for you. This do in remembrance of me! After the same manner he took also the cup, when they had eaten at evening, gave thanks unto God his heavenly Father, and gave it to them, saying: Take! Drink ye all of it! This is the cup, the new testament in my blood, which is shed for you and for many for the forgiveness of sins. This do, as oft as ye drink it, in remembrance of me! Holy, holy, holy is God the Lord almighty. Heaven and earth are full of thy glory. Save us in the highest! Blessed be he that cometh in the name of the Lord! Save us in the highest!

Note.

- **The chalice.** "Here the priest prepareth the chalice" is all that is left of the offertory, as in Döber (§7.8.1). It stands after the Creed, where the Roman offertory stood.
- **The Preface and Verba.** The Preface cut off at *per Christum Dominum nostrum* (through Christ our Lord) runs into the Verba on the pattern of the *Formula missae* (Form of the Mass). Sehling: "an independent translation of the introduction to the account of the institution created by Luther". The Verba are from 1 Cor 11 and the Gospels, not from *Qui pridie* (Who the day before).
- **The Sanctus** comes after the Verba. "Make us blessed" translates *Hosanna* (Sehling: "Help now!").

Priest: Let us pray, admonished by wholesome precepts: Our Father, which art in heaven, hallowed be thy name! Thy kingdom come! Thy will be done, as in heaven, so in earth! Give us this day our daily bread, and forgive us our debts, as we forgive our debtors! And lead us not into temptation, but deliver us from evil! Amen. *The priest turneth to the people, saying:* The peace of the Lord be alway with you! *Answer:* And with thy spirit! O thou Lamb of God, that takest away the sin of the world, have mercy upon us! O thou Lamb of God, that takest away the sin of the world, have mercy upon us! O thou Lamb of God, that takest away the sin of the world, have mercy upon us and give us peace!

Note.

- **"Let us pray, reminded by wholesome precepts".** This is *Oremus: Praeceptis salutaribus moniti*, with *praecepta* ("precepts") read as "gebet" (prayer).
- **The *Pax*** is kept with its Roman response. There is no embolism and no fraction.

O Lord Jesu Christ, thou hast said unto thy disciples: Peace I give unto you; my peace I leave with you; not as the world giveth, give I it unto you. Wherefore, my Lord, look not upon our sins, but upon the faith of thy Christian Church, which we believe and see not; which vouchsafe thou, according to thy divine will, to keep, unite and govern, with thy heavenly Father and the Holy Ghost, for ever. Amen. *Another prayer:* O Lord Jesu Christ, thou Son of the living God, who by the will of thy Father, with the working together of the Holy Ghost, hast by thy death made the world alive again: deliver us by the taking of thy body and blood from all our sins and from all evil, and grant us that we may at all times cleave unto thy divine commandments, and never more be parted from thee! Who with God thy heavenly Father and the Holy Ghost livest and reignest for ever. Amen. *Another prayer:* Let the receiving of thy flesh and blood, Jesu Christ, which we poor sinners partake unto the forgiveness of our sins, not be suffered to turn to us unto judgement or damnation, but be our defence here and there for ever! Amen.

Note. These are the priest's three prayers before communion, in German, twenty years before Brandenburg kept them in Latin (§7.12.5). Sehling thought only one of them was meant to be chosen ("Alia oratio").

1. ***Domine Iesu Christe, qui dixisti.***
    - John 14:27 is given in full, including "not as the world giveth" (not in the Roman prayer).
    - "which we then believe and see not" is added.
    - The Tridentine verbs are *pacificare et coadunare* (to keep in peace and unite). Volprecht's "keep, unite, govern" are instead the *custodire, adunare et regere* (to guard, unite and govern) of *Te igitur* (Thee therefore), as in Brandenburg's Latin (§7.12.5).
2. ***Fili Dei vivi.***
    - *Per hoc sacrosanctum Corpus et Sanguinem tuum* (by this thy most holy Body and Blood) becomes "through the taking of thy body and blood". The deliverance comes through receiving, not through the consecrated elements.
    - *Inhaerere* is kept ("anhangen").
    - The prayer is plural.
3. ***Perceptio Corporis tui.*** The body and blood are named ("flesh and blood").
    - *Praesumo* (I presume) disappears; "in forgiveness of our sins" is added.
    - *Tutamentum mentis et corporis, et ad medelam percipiendam* (a defence of mind and body, and for a healing remedy) is shortened to "protection here and there".

Here he receiveth the body of Christ, saying: The body of our Lord Jesus Christ, which is given for us, preserve my soul unto everlasting life! Amen. Let us also drink the cup of salvation and call upon the name of the Lord! *Here he receiveth the blood, saying:* The blood of our Lord Jesus Christ, which is shed for us, preserve my soul unto everlasting life! Amen. *Straightway let him say:* What we have received with the mouth, grant, almighty God, that we may receive it also with a pure heart, that of a temporal gift it may become unto us an everlasting medicine! *Another prayer:* May the body and the blood of the Lord, which we have received, cleave alway inwardly unto our hearts; and grant, almighty God, that there remain not in us a stain of sin, who hast fed us with thy holy sacraments!

Note.

- **The priest's communion.**
    - ***Custodiat.*** "Preserve my soul unto everlasting life" is *Corpus Domini nostri Iesu Christi custodiat animam meam in vitam aeternam* (The body of our Lord Jesus Christ preserve my soul unto everlasting life). "which is given for us" is added.

    - ***Calicem salutaris.*** "Let us also drink the cup of salvation" is *Calicem salutaris accipiam* (I will take the cup of salvation; Ps 116:13), plural, as in Kantz (§7.2.6).
- **The ablution prayers.**
    - ***Quod ore sumpsimus*** is complete: "What we have taken with our mouth, O Lord, may we receive with a pure mind; and from a temporal gift may it become for us an everlasting remedy".
    - ***Corpus tuum*** is made plural: "Thy Body, O Lord, which I have taken, and thy Blood, which I have drunk, cleave unto my inmost parts; and grant that no stain of sin may remain in me, whom pure and holy sacraments have refreshed". "Visceribus" (inmost parts) becomes "inwardly in our hearts".
    - Sehling again thinks only one of the two was meant.
- **No communion of the people is provided for** in the text. The exhortation printed after the Mass (the Nürnberg exhortation, §7.8.7) is for those who "would go to God's table, before or during the Mass".

Communion: We praise the God of heaven, and confess before all that live, that he hath dealt with us according to his mercy. *Priest:* The Lord be with you! *Answer:* And with thy spirit! *Priest:* Let us pray! May the receiving of thy sacrament, O Lord our God, which we have taken, come unto us for the health of body and also of soul, and for the confession of the eternal holy Trinity and undivided Unity; through our Lord Jesus Christ, thy Son, who with thee liveth and reigneth in the unity of the Holy Ghost, ever and everlastingly! Amen. *Priest:* The Lord be with you! *Answer:* And with thy spirit! *Thereafter the priest speaketh the blessing thus:* The Lord bless you and keep you! The Lord make his face shine upon you and be gracious unto you! The Lord lift up his countenance upon you and give you peace! *Answer:* Amen. *Priest:* Let us give praise and thanks unto the Lord! *Answer:* Thanks be to God. *The end of the Mass.*

Note.

- **The Mass is that of Trinity Sunday**, from the Bamberg missal. The communion chant is "We bless the God of heaven, and before all the living we will confess him, because he hath shown his mercy to us" (Tob 12:6).
- **The postcommunion** is the Roman postcommunion of Trinity Sunday: "May the receiving of this sacrament, O Lord our God, profit us for the health of body and soul, and the everlasting confession of the holy Trinity and of its undivided Unity". Lippe uses it too (§7.10).
- **The ending.** "Let us give praise and thanks to the Lord / God be thanked" is the *Benedicamus Domino / Deo gratias*. The Aaronic blessing (Luther's suggestion, §7.3.5) stands before it.

7.7.3 *Form und Ordnung einer Christlichen Messe*, 1525

After that the priest beginneth the Preface, in the Sunday tone: The Lord be with you! *Choir:* And with thy spirit! Lift up your hearts, etc., as far as "through Christ our Lord". *Thereafter he beginneth the Qui pridie, and as soon as the priest hath elevated, the choir beginneth the Sanctus. After the same the priest singeth the Pater noster, with the beginning:* Let us pray: Taught by wholesome precepts, etc. *After the Pater noster the priest or minister readeth the exhortation toward the people:* My dearly beloved in God, etc. *When that is ended, the priest turneth toward the people and singeth:* The peace of the Lord be alway with you! *Choir:* And with thy spirit! *Thereafter the choir beginneth the Agnus Dei, as followeth hereafter. Meanwhile the priest communicateth the people and saith first:* The body of our Lord Jesus Christ preserve thy soul unto everlasting life! *Then:* The blood of our Lord Jesus Christ preserve thy soul unto everlasting life! […] *Immediately after the Agnus Dei the choir beginneth a psalm for the communion, or else a hymn. After the same the priest concludeth the Mass with a collect. Thereafter with the Benedicamus Domino, in the Sunday tone.*

Note.

- **The shape.** This is the Mass of the parish churches (§7.7.1) as sung by 1525: shortened Preface, *Qui pridie* (Who the day before; Sehling: presumably sung in Latin), elevation, Sanctus, *Praeceptis salutaribus* (Taught by saving precepts) and the Our Father, the exhortation, *Pax Domini* (The peace of the Lord).
- **What is new** is the German *custodiat* (preserve) at the distribution, in the second person.
- **What follows in the print.** The German Sanctus and *Agnus Dei* (Lamb of God) printed after the rubrics ("Lamb of God, that takest away the sin of the world …") are omitted here.

7.8 Nürnberg, Döber's *Deutsche Messe*, 1525

Andreas Döber's German Mass for the Neues Spital, Nürnberg. Sehling 11, I.6, pp. 52–55.

Döber follows the order Luther proposed in the *Formula missae* (1523), as Nürnberg's parish churches had done in 1524. There is no offertory. A truncated Preface runs straight into the Verba, and the Sanctus follows the Verba. Of the Canon, only the Verba remain in place. The Roman prayers after the Our Father survive as three things: a remnant of the embolism, a German *Agnus Dei* (Lamb of God), and the *Domine Iesu Christe, Fili Dei vivi* (O Lord Jesus Christ, Son of the living God), which is turned into a prayer for the people to repeat.

7.8.1 Preparation of the gifts (after the Gradual)

After the Epistle followeth the Gradual. After the same the priest prepareth the cup together with the bread. […] *After the Alleluia the priest asketh the server whether any have announced himself to receive the holy sacrament. Thereupon he maketh ready; and when that is done, he turneth himself to the people, or layeth the book upon the desk, and readeth the Gospel, John 6.*

Note. This is all that is left of the offertory: a silent preparation, moved in front of the Gospel, with no prayers. The Nicene or Apostles' Creed follows the Gospel. The Mass then goes on at once to the Preface.

7.8.2 Preface

After that the priest beginneth the Preface: The Lord be with you! *The people:* And with thy spirit! *The priest:* Lift up your hearts unto God! *The people:* We have lifted up our hearts. *The priest:* Let us give thanks unto God our Lord! *The people:* It is meet and right. *The priest:* Yea verily, it is meet and right, and also wholesome, that we should in all places give thanks unto thee, O Lord, holy Father, almighty, everlasting God, through Christ our Lord. Amen.

Note. This is Luther's shortened Preface from the *Formula missae* (Form of the Mass). It was meant to end at *per Christum Dominum nostrum* (through Christ our Lord) and to run straight into the relative clause *Qui pridie* (Who the day before). Sehling notes that Döber's "Amen" breaks that join, and shows that Döber "did not understand its sense".

7.8.3 The Verba

Thereafter the priest saith, and taketh the bread into his hands: Who, in the night in which he was betrayed, took the bread into his holy hands, gave thanks unto his heavenly Father, blessed it, brake it, and gave it to his disciples, and said unto them: Take and eat! This is my body, which is given for you. This do in remembrance of me! *And he showeth it to the people. Now he taketh the cup into his hand:* Likewise also he took the cup into his holy hands, gave thanks unto his heavenly Father, blessed it, and gave it to his disciples, and said: Take and drink ye all of this! This is the cup of the new testament with my blood, which is shed for you and for many for the forgiveness of sins. As oft as ye do this, do it in remembrance of me! *And he showeth it to the people.*

Note. The frame is the Canon's:

- "into his holy hands" renders *in sanctas ac venerabiles manus suas* (into his holy and venerable hands);
- "giveth thanks to his heavenly Father" renders *ad te Deum Patrem suum omnipotentem, tibi gratias agens* (unto thee, God his almighty Father, giving thanks to thee);
- "As oft as ye do this" renders *Haec quotiescumque feceritis* (As often as ye shall do these things).

The opening, though, is Paul's "in the night in which he was betrayed" (1 Cor 11:23), not *Qui pridie* (Who the day before). In the 1524 order of the parish churches (Sehling 11, I.5, p. 47) the Verba were still said in Latin, *Qui pridie … Hoc est enim corpus meum … mysterium fidei* (Who the day before … For this is my body … the mystery of faith).

7.8.4 Sanctus

After this he saith the Sanctus, as followeth. The Sanctus: Holy, holy, holy, Lord God of Sabaoth. Full are the heavens and the earth of thy glory and majesty. Ah, save us in the height! Blessed be he that cometh in the name of the Lord! Save us in the heights!

Note. *Hosanna* is translated by its meaning, "help/save us" ("make us blessed"), as in Volprecht's Mass of 1524.

7.8.5 Our Father and the remnant of the embolism

Thereafter the priest shall say, as it standeth in Matthew the sixth: When the disciples came unto the Lord Jesus and besought him that he should teach them to pray, he said: When ye will pray, ye shall not babble much, as the hypocrites do; for they think that when they make many words they shall be heard. But say thus, as hereafter followeth: Our Father, which art in the heavens, hallowed be thy name! Thy kingdom come unto us! Thy will be done as in heaven and in earth! Give us this day our daily bread, and forgive us our debts, as we also forgive our debtors! And lead us not into temptation, but deliver us from evil! Amen. *And he saith further:* O Lord, deliver us from all visible and invisible enemies, from the devil, from the world, from our own flesh; through Christ Jesus our Lord. Amen.

Note.

- **The introduction to the Our Father.** *Praeceptis salutaribus moniti* (Admonished by saving precepts) is replaced by Christ's own warrant (Mt 6:7; Lk 11:1). Sehling calls it an "reshaping of the introduction".
- **The embolism.** The prayer after the Our Father is what Sehling calls the "remnant of the embolism". It keeps the *Libera nos … Domine* (Deliver us … O Lord) form and the *Per … Christum* (Through … Christ) ending. The "evils past, present and to come", the saints and the petition for peace give way to the Lutheran triad of devil, world and flesh.

7.8.6 Salutation and *Agnus Dei*

Thereafter the priest turneth to the people and saith: The Lord be with you! *The people:* And with thy spirit! *After that the priest saith:* O thou Lamb of God, that takest away the sin of the world, have mercy upon us! O thou Lamb of God, that takest away the sin of the world, give us peace!

Note. *Dominus vobiscum* (The Lord be with you) stands where *Pax Domini sit semper vobiscum* (The peace of the Lord be always with you) stood.

7.8.7 The exhortation (Osiander)

After this the priest turneth to the people and saith the exhortation, as hereafter followeth. My dearly beloved in God! Forasmuch as we will now consider and keep the supper of our Lord Jesus Christ, wherein his flesh and blood are given us for meat and for drink, not of the body but of the soul, we ought rightly with great diligence every one to examine himself, as Paul saith, and so to eat of this bread and drink of this cup. For none but a hungry soul, which knoweth its sin, feareth God's wrath and death, and is hungry and thirsty after righteousness, ought to receive this holy sacrament. But when we examine ourselves, we find nothing in us but sin and death, and could in no wise help ourselves out thereof. Therefore hath our dear Lord Jesus Christ had mercy upon us, and for our sakes is become man, that he might fulfil the law for us and suffer that which we had deserved with our sins. And that we might steadfastly believe this and joyfully rely thereupon, he took after the supper the bread, gave thanks, brake it, and said: Take and eat! This is my body, which is given for you; as if he would say: That I am become man, and all that I do and suffer, that is all your own, done for you and for your good. For a sure token thereof I give you my body for meat. Likewise also the cup, and said: Take and drink ye all of this! This is the cup of the new testament with my blood, which is shed for you and for many for the forgiveness of sins. As oft as ye do this, ye shall remember me thereby! As if he would say: Forasmuch as I have taken your cause upon me and laden your sins upon myself, I will offer myself unto death for sin, shed my blood, obtain grace and forgiveness of sins, and so set up a new testament, wherein sin shall be remembered no more for ever. For a sure token thereof I give you my blood to drink. Whosoever now eateth thus of this bread and drinketh of this cup, that is, whosoever firmly believeth these words which he heareth and these signs which he receiveth, he dwelleth in Christ and Christ in him, and so liveth for ever. Hereby shall we remember his death and give him thanks therefor, every one take up his cross and follow him, and above all love one another, as he also hath loved us; for we being many are one bread and one body, who are all partakers of one bread and drink of one cup. God grant us all this, that we may receive it worthily. Amen.

Note. Sehling does not reprint the text here. He points to the order of the parish churches of 1524 (Sehling 11, I.5, p. 48), whose base text is **Osiander's** exhortation from the provosts' *Grundt und ursach* (1524).

The text above is that base text with **Döber's readings (Sehling's siglum D)** taken from his apparatus:

- "My dearly beloved";
- "could in no wise [help] ourselves";
- "that he for us";
- "for pardon";
- "shall never be remembered";

- "for a sure token";
- "in Christ" without "the Lord";
- "hold dear";
- the closing sentence "God grant this unto us all …", which p. 54 confirms.

One point is uncertain. For "Thereof for [a] sure token" (the bread) the apparatus is garbled; it seems to say D lacks *ainem* (a).

In Nürnberg this exhortation stood where the Latin Verba had been read silently. Once the Verba were sung aloud in German, Sehling notes, the exhortation "doubled" them.

7.8.8 *Domine Iesu Christe, Fili Dei vivi*, said by the people

After this exhortation the priest turneth to the altar and saith to the people: Say after me: O Lord Jesus Christ, thou eternal Word of the Father, thou Saviour of the world, thou true, living God and man, deliver us by thy holy body and rose-red blood from all sins! Help that we may fulfil thy commandments at all times, and be not separated from thee for ever! Amen.

Note. This is "O Lord Jesus Christ, Son of the living God, who by the will of the Father, the Holy Spirit working with thee, hast by thy death given life to the world: deliver me by this thy most holy Body and Blood from all mine iniquities and from all evils; and make me always to cleave to thy commandments, and suffer me never to be separated from thee". Sehling calls it "slightly reshaped", as in Volprecht's Mass.

- **Opening.** The Trinitarian opening is replaced by titles of Christ.
- **Number and speaker.** *Me* becomes *uns* (us).
- **Words for body and blood.** *Fronleichnam* (the Lord's body) is the old word for the Lord's body (as in *Fronleichnamsfest*, Corpus Christi). *Rosenfarbes blut* (rose-coloured blood) is a late-medieval devotional epithet.
- **Who says it.** The priest's private preparation before his communion is now said by the people after him.

7.8.9 Communion

Now he communicateth the people first, if he will; and when he reacheth them the body of Christ, he saith unto them: The body of Christ preserve thy soul unto everlasting life! *The same he saith also when he taketh it himself. And thereafter he taketh the cup and saith:* The blood of our dear Lord Jesus Christ, which is shed for me and for you unto the forgiveness of sins, preserve my soul unto everlasting life! *And when he hath consumed, he bindeth up the cup.*

Note. These are *Corpus Domini nostri Iesu Christi custodiat animam tuam in vitam aeternam* (The body of our Lord Jesus Christ preserve thy soul unto everlasting life) and the priest's *Sanguis Domini nostri Iesu Christi custodiat animam meam …* (The blood of our Lord Jesus Christ preserve my soul …), with "which is shed for me and for you for the forgiveness of sins" added.

"Let him bind up the chalice" means he wraps the chalice in its bag.

7.8.10 *Nunc dimittis*, postcommunion, dismissal and blessing

After the same he saith to the people: Say after me: O Lord, now let thy servant depart in peace according to thy word; for our eyes have seen thy salvation, which thou hast prepared before the face of all peoples, a light to lighten the Gentiles and to be the glory of thy people Israel. To thee be praise, honour and thanks, O thou holy, blessed, glorious Trinity, God the Father, God the Son and Holy Ghost! Amen. *After this the priest turneth to the people and saith thus:* The Lord be with you! *The people:* And with thy spirit! *Thereafter he saith the collect to the people:* Let us pray: O Lord, almighty God, grant unto us in our mind and heart that, through the temporal death of thy Son, which these worthy mysteries signify, we may trust that thou hast given us everlasting life; through the Christ our Lord. Amen. *Last of all he turneth about to the people and saith:* The Lord be with you! *The people:* And with thy spirit! *The priest:* Give thanks unto the Lord! *The people:* God be praise and thanks! *The priest:* Incline your hearts unto God, and I will give you the blessing! *And he saith:* The Lord bless thee and keep thee, and lighten his countenance upon thee, and have mercy upon thee, and turn his countenance unto thee, and give thee everlasting peace; in the name of the Father and of the Son and of the Holy Ghost! Amen. Go ye in the peace of the Lord! *Now the priest goeth away from the altar.* So have ye the end of this evangelical Mass. God grant us that which is profitable for soul and body! Amen.

Note.

- **The collect.** It follows the Roman postcommunion of Wednesday in Holy Week: "Grant to our senses, almighty God, that through the temporal death of thy Son, which the venerable mysteries witness, we may trust that thou hast given us everlasting life". Sehling calls it "apparently newly made"; the Roman source is identified here for the first time. Note that *testantur* ("bear witness to") is rendered *bedeuten* (signify).
- **The dismissal.** "Give thanks unto the Lord … To God be praise and thanks" answers to *Benedicamus Domino / Deo gratias*. Sehling reads "Go in the peace of the Lord" as a paraphrase of *Ite, missa est* (Go, it is the dismissal).

7.8.11 Optional intercession in the place of *Te igitur*

There followeth a common prayer, to be said on a feast day when much people is present, after the Preface or before the Sanctus, as one will. Almighty, everlasting God and merciful Father: forasmuch as thy Son our Lord Jesus Christ hath promised that whatsoever we ask in his name, thou wilt grant it us; and moreover, forasmuch as thy Spirit also hath commanded that we should pray for our magistrates: we beseech thee from our hearts that thou wouldest move the minds of the emperor, the princes and lords, and above all of our lords and superiors of an honourable council, unto the knowledge of thy goodness and of the Gospel; and also that thou wouldest make all peoples subject unto thy Son through the Holy Ghost, that they themselves may willingly acknowledge, receive and keep his promise; and above all grant unto this congregation that it may increase in the knowledge of the Gospel, and of his sweet yoke and easy burden. Forasmuch now, almighty, everlasting God, beloved and merciful Father, as thine only Son our Lord Jesus is come into the world to be a physician of the sick and not of the whole, and yet our blindness cannot of itself see the present shame of sin nor know it for a sickness, for we are, alas, poisoned, and please ourselves in our error and transgression, hate the commandments of God and love vices: we pray thee that thou wouldest, through God the Holy Ghost, write thy law in our hearts and make the hidden sin alive in us, and so grant us that we may prove and perceive how impossible it is for us to do good; that we may gain a hunger and thirst after the grace and righteousness which alone availeth before thee, which thou hast given to the world through Christ Jesus our Lord. *After this followeth the Qui pridie. God be praised!*

Note. Sehling traces the prayer to the Strasbourg order of 1524 (Moderate Reformed). Its rubric puts it exactly where *Te igitur* (Thee therefore) stood: after the Preface, before the Sanctus in Döber's order, and leading into *Qui pridie* (Who the day before). It intercedes for the emperor, princes and council, for all peoples, and for "this congregation". These are the intentions of *Te igitur* and the *Memento*, turned into an evangelical prayer for faith and for the knowledge of sin.

7.9 Bremen, *Eyne evangelysce Misse*, 1525 (Kantz in Low German)

Eyne evangelysce Misse myt etlijke schone gebede … (An evangelical Mass with some fine prayers …) Bremen 1525. Sehling 7, III, Nr. 1, pp. 403–407 (eko.db doc 2216).

The Mass itself is Kantz's order of 1522 (§7.2) in Low German. Before it stand three devotional prayers for the communicant. The second is a "meditation at the Mass". Its opening confession of the Real Presence is the nearest thing in the order to a Canon.

The foreword warns that the prayers are no rule: they are meant to show "what faith and desire are needed to receive the testament of Christ in a Christian manner".

7.9.1 The meditation during Mass

A meditation at the Mass Almighty, everlasting God, my Lord Jesu Christ, I believe that in this bread is present thy holy true body, and in this wine thy precious blood, which thou hast taken upon thee to redeem Adam and all his posterity from everlasting death. And thou hast left us in this most worthy Sacrament a sure and certain sign of thy true promise to forgive sins, which thy words witness that are spoken in the Mass: Take and eat. This is my body, which is given for you. Take and drink ye all thereof. This is my blood, which is shed for you for the forgiveness of sins. Upon such comfortable promise I desire from my whole heart, in right confidence and good trust, that thou let me not go hence empty and hungry, unfed, but wilt feed and refresh me with thy living word, which proclaimeth unto us the forgiveness of our sins through thy body and blood; that I may be established in true love toward thee and brotherly faithfulness toward my neighbour.

Note.

- **Who is addressed.** The prayer is addressed to Christ as "Almighty, eternal God" and confesses the Real Presence "in this bread … in this wine".

- **The Verba** are quoted from "the words spoken in the Mass": the priest's words are now heard by the congregation.
- **The Roman background.** It is the priest's private preparation for communion, of the kind in the late-medieval *Praeparatio ad missam* (preparation for Mass), given to the laity.

7.9.2 The Mass: preparation

The preparation follows Kantz (§7.2.1–7.2.2) closely:

- the exhortation "Dearest in Christ, that ye may receive with joyful and desirous heart the precious treasure and the testament of the flesh and blood of Christ Jesus …";
- the absolution;
- "The priest's confession", the recast *Orate fratres*: "pray ye also God faithfully for me, that he, forgiving me my sins, make me meet to distribute his signs to you";
- Ps 124:8;
- the *Veni Sancte Spiritus* (Come, Holy Spirit) antiphon, said "secretly" by all;
- Kantz's collect, "O Lord, almighty God, help that thy Holy Ghost may be and dwell with us …".

7.9.3 Preface, Sanctus, *Quam oblationem* and *Qui pridie*

The Preface, or foreword of the Mass Lift up your hearts to God, and let us give thanks unto God our Lord. For it is meet, right and wholesome that we should in all places and at all times give thanks unto thee, O Lord, holy Father, almighty, everlasting God, through Christ our dear Lord, through whom all angels and heavenly powers worship, honour and praise thy holy majesty. With the same we beseech thee, vouchsafe to admit and receive our voice, that we also may praise thee and say without end: Sanctus: That is: Holy, holy, holy, Lord God of hosts. Full are heaven and earth of thy glory. Hosanna in the highest. Blessed be he that cometh in the name of the Lord. Luck and salvation in the highest. *Here beginneth first the Evangelical Mass A prayer to God beforehand* O most gracious Father, merciful, everlasting God, grant us that we may firmly believe that this bread and wine becometh the true body and blood of thy most dear Son, our Lord Jesus Christ; who on the day before his passion took the bread into his holy hands, looked up to heaven unto thee, his almighty Father, gave thanks, and brake the bread, and gave it to his disciples, saying: Take and eat, this is my body, which is given for you. Likewise, after the supper, he took the cup into his holy hands, thanked his Father, and gave it to his disciples, and spake: Take and drink ye all thereout, this is the cup of the new and everlasting testament in my blood, which is shed for you and for many for the forgiveness of sins. As often as ye do this, do it in my remembrance.

Note.

- **The recast *Quam oblationem*.** Sehling's note: "This prayer corresponds largely to the prayer *Quam oblationem* of the Roman Missal". Kantz's petition "help, that this bread and the wine may become and be for us …" (*ut nobis … fiat*) has become "grant us that we may firmly believe that this bread and wine becometh …". The prayer no longer asks that the bread become the body. It asks that we believe that it does.
- **The Verba.** Kantz's two *benedixit* ("blesseth") are dropped.

7.9.4 Our Father, *Agnus Dei*, *Fili Dei vivi*, communion, *Nunc dimittis*

Let us pray: Our Father, which art in heaven. Hallowed be thy name. Thy kingdom come unto us. Thy will be done, as in heaven, so also on earth. Give us this day our daily bread. And forgive us our debt, as we forgive our debtors. And lead us not into temptation, but deliver us from all evil. Through our Lord Jesus Christ, thy Son, who with thee and the Holy Ghost, one true God, liveth and reigneth for ever. *Agnus Dei* (Lamb of God) O thou Lamb of God, that bearest the sin of the world, have mercy upon us and give us thy peace. *A prayer before the receiving of the most worthy Sacrament* O Lord Jesu Christ, thou everlasting Word of thy Father, thou Saviour of the world, living God, deliver us through thy bottomless mercy from all sins. Help us that we may fulfil thy commandments at all times, and never be parted from thee for ever. *Hereafter shall the priest give the most worthy Sacrament to them that desire it with a hungry, sinful heart, saying thus:* Be comforted. For behold, this is the body of our Lord Jesus Christ, which suffered for you the bitter death. Take and eat, that it may feed you and preserve you unto everlasting life. *When they have all been communicated with the body of Christ, the priest shall take the cup with the precious blood of Christ, and say thus:* Now will we also drink the cup of salvation and call upon the name of the Lord. Behold, ye troubled, sinful hearts, and be comforted. For this is the precious, costly treasure of the blood of our Lord Jesus Christ, wherewith ye are bought. Take this and divide it among yourselves to the washing away of your sins. *When all this is done, the priest shall with the whole Christian*

congregation thank and praise the Lord with this song of praise, saying: O Lord, now let thy servant depart in peace according to thy words, for our eyes have seen thy salvation, which thou hast prepared before the face of all people, a light to lighten the Gentiles and for a glory of thy people Israel. To thee be praise and thanks, O thou holy, blessed Trinity, God the Father, Son, Holy Ghost.

Note.

- **As in Kantz (§7.2.5–7.2.7):**
  - the conclusion of the embolism after the Our Father;
  - one *Agnus Dei*;
  - an abridged *Fili Dei vivi* (Son of the living God);
  - the *custodiat* ("feed and preserve unto everlasting life");
  - *Calicem salutaris* (The cup of salvation);
  - the *Nunc dimittis* with a Trinitarian doxology.
- **What changes from Kantz:**
  - ***Fili Dei vivi.*** Kantz's "deliver us by this thy holy body and rose-coloured blood" (*per hoc sacrosanctum Corpus et Sanguinem tuum*, by this thy most holy Body and Blood) becomes "through thy bottomless mercy". Bremen removes the one phrase that ascribed the deliverance to the consecrated elements.
  - **The communicants** are "they that desire it with a hungry, sinful heart".
  - **Omitted.** The showing of the host and the *Pax* are gone. No fraction, as in Kantz's first edition.
- **What follows.** A German *Te Deum* (We praise thee, O God).

7.10 Lippe, *Deutsche Messe*, [1525–1538] (Müntzer in Low German)

Sehling 22, IX (Lippe, Nachtrag), Nr. 1, pp. 565–569 (eko.db doc 1549). It is a manuscript Mass with notes, for Trinity Sunday.

Its eucharistic part is Müntzer's German Mass (§7.4; Radical Reformation) in Low German, taken into a Lutheran order:

- the *Per omnia saecula* (World without end) before the Preface;
- the Roman *Qui pridie* (Who the day before) with "lifted up his eyes" and "a mystery of the faith";
- "Therefore let us all pray as Jesus Christ … hath taught us";
- the *Per omnia saecula* after the Our Father;
- *Pax Domini* (The peace of the Lord).

Its propers are those of Volprecht's Trinity Mass (§7.7.2): Rom 11:33–36, John 15:26–16:4, the Alleluia *Benedictus es, Domine, Deus patrum nostrorum* (Blessed art thou, O Lord God of our fathers), and the *Proficiat* (May [the receiving] profit) postcommunion.

Müntzer's own German Mass has no Trinity Mass. The Erfurt *Kirchenamt* of 1525, which reprinted Müntzer's Masses, added one (Sehling 6, III, p. 812 n. 26, to Calenberg-Göttingen 1542, §7.13). An Erfurt print of this kind is the likely source of the Lippe text.

The offertory For the offertory a spiritual song is sung, that is, a psalm. The Preface World without end. Amen. The Lord be with you. And with thy spirit. Our hearts on high. We have them unto the Lord. We give thanks unto the Lord our God. It is meet and right. Verily it is meet and right, and moreover very wholesome, that we should always and in all places give thanks unto thee, Lord, holy Father, almighty, everlasting God, who with thine only-begotten Son and the Holy Ghost art one only God, art one only Lord; not in the oneness of a person, but in the oneness of a single being. For that which by thine own revelation we believe of thy glory, even the same we hold, without difference, of thy Son and of the Holy Ghost; that in the confession of the true and everlasting Godhead, the propriety in the persons and the unity in the being and the equality in the majesty may be rightly worshipped; which the angels praise, the archangels honour, and thereto Cherubim and Seraphim, who without ceasing sing with one accord of voice: Holy, holy, holy art thou, Lord God of hosts, heaven and earth are filled with thy praise. Ah, help us, thou that art in the highest. Blessed be he that cometh in the name of the Lord. Ah, give luck and salvation in the highest.

Note.

- **The offertory.** It keeps its name and its place, as a German hymn.
- **"Through all eternity of eternity, amen"** heads the "Prefatio" (Preface). It is the *Per omnia saecula saeculorum. Amen* (World without end. Amen) that ended the silent Secret, as in Müntzer (§7.4.1).

- **The Preface** is the Trinity Preface, rendered fully:
    - "Who with thine only-begotten Son and the Holy Spirit art one God, one Lord: not in the singularity of one person, but in the Trinity of one substance …";
    - "… and in the persons propriety, and in the essence unity, and in the majesty equality may be adored. Which the Angels praise and the Archangels, the Cherubim also and Seraphim …".

  "In the oneness of a single being" renders *in unius Trinitate substantiae* (in the Trinity of one substance) loosely.
- **The Sanctus.** "Ah, help us" is *Hosanna*.

The day before, when Jesus would suffer, he took the bread into his holy hands, and lifted up his eyes to heaven unto thee, God, his almighty Father, and said thanks unto thee, and blessed it, and brake it, and gave it to his disciples, saying: Take and eat thereof, this is my body, which is given for you. *Here he giveth the sacrament to the people who will be communicated. Thereafter he taketh the cup in his hand and saith:* In like manner, when they had eaten, he took the cup into his holy and worthy hands, and said thanks unto thee, and blessed it, and gave it to his disciples, saying: Take and drink ye all thereout. This is the cup of my blood, of the new and everlasting covenant, a mystery of faith, which is shed for you and for many for the forgiveness of sins. As often as ye do this, ye shall remember me thereby. *Here he giveth the people who are communicated the cup also; meanwhile the hymn "Gott sei gelobet" is sung, or "Jesus Christus unser Heiland", or the German Sanctus.*

Note.

- **The Verba** are word for word Müntzer's *Qui pridie* (§7.4.2), with *mysterium fidei* (the mystery of faith).
- **The order of communion.** As Luther proposed in the *Deutsche Messe* (German Mass), the bread is given after the bread-word and the cup after the cup-word. So the Our Father, the *Pax* and the *Agnus Dei* (Lamb of God) come *after* communion.

Therefore let us all pray, as Jesus Christ, the Son of God, hath taught us, saying: Our Father, which art in the heavens, hallowed be thy name, thy kingdom come. Thy will be done on earth as in heaven. Give us this day our daily bread, and forgive us our debt, as we forgive our debtors, and lead us not into temptation, but deliver us from evil, amen. This be done through our Lord Jesus Christ, thy Son, who with thee and the Holy Ghost, one true God, liveth and reigneth for ever, amen. World without end. Amen. The peace of the Lord be alway with you, and with thy spirit. O Lamb of God, that bearest the sin of the world, have mercy upon us. O Lamb of God, that bearest the sin of the world, give us thy peace. *The communion For the communion a psalm or spiritual song of praise is sung. Thereafter the pastor saith to the people:* The Lord be with you. *Answer:* And with thy spirit. O Lord God, let the receiving of the holy Sacrament, and the everlasting confession of the holy and self-subsistent undivided Trinity, profit us for body and soul; who livest and reignest one only God, world without end, amen. Let us bless the Lord; thanks be to God for ever. The Lord bless thee and keep thee, and make his face shine upon thee, and have mercy upon thee, and turn his face unto thee and give thee peace, amen.

Note.

- **The embolism's two endings.** Lippe has both:
    - Kantz's "That be done through our Lord …", the conclusion *Per eundem Dominum* (Through the same Lord);
    - Müntzer's "Through all eternity of eternity", the chant ending *Per omnia saecula*.

  There is no fraction rubric.
- ***Pax Domini*** is kept with its response. The response is run on in the manuscript.
- **The postcommunion** is the Roman *Proficiat* of Trinity Sunday, as in Volprecht (§7.7.2).
- **The blessing.** "Let us bless the Lord; to God be thanks for ever" is Müntzer's *Benedicamus*. The Aaronic blessing follows.

7.11 Schleswig-Holstein, a Low German Mass from Kiel, [after 1526]

Sehling 23, A, Nr. 1, pp. 55–57 (`eko.db` doc 1576; introduction in doc 1568, p. 39). The manuscript, with notes, was bound into a book of the Kiel preacher Rudolf von Nimwegen († 1542). Sehling's editor dates it after 1526 because it draws on Döber (1525) and on Luther's *Deutsche Messe* (1526).

The order also draws on:

- **Kantz** (§7.2): the *Veni Sancte Spiritus* (Come, Holy Spirit) and its collect.
- **Müntzer** (§7.4): the Roman *Qui pridie* (Who the day before), with "lifted up his eyes".
- **Döber** (§7.8): the *Fili Dei vivi* (Son of the living God) said by the people after the priest.

It is the only order in the corpus with a German *Domine, non sum dignus* (Lord, I am not worthy).

7.11.1 Before the altar: absolution by the sexton, *Veni Sancte Spiritus*, collect

The minister readeth: Misereatur. The sexton readeth: Misereatur. The almighty, merciful God forgive us our sins. And I, by the commandment of our Lord Jesus Christ, say unto you that trust in God's grace and believe his words, free, quit and loosed of all your sins. In the name of the Father and of the Son and of the Holy Ghost. *The priest:* Amen. *The priest readeth:* Come, Holy Ghost, fill the hearts of thy faithful and kindle in them the fire of thy divine love, who through the diversity of tongues hast gathered the peoples of the whole world in the unity of the true faith. *Sexton:* Amen. *The priest readeth:* O Lord, almighty God, grant that thy Holy Ghost may be and dwell with us, that he may enlighten us and teach all truth. Strengthen and defend in all adversity; through Christ our Lord. *The sexton:* Amen.

Note.

- **The absolution.** "Myseriator" (*Misereatur*) and the absolution are Kantz's (§7.2.1), but read by the sexton. The priest only adds the *Amen*. Sehling's editor points to Hadeln 1526 for the same practice.
- **The prayers.** The antiphon and collect are Kantz's (§7.2.2), said before the priest goes to the altar. Then the antiphon is sung again, with notes, and a troped Kyrie follows.

7.11.2 Preface and the bread-word

The Lord be with you. Our hearts on high. We give thanks unto the Lord our God. Verily it is worthy and right, meet and wholesome, that we, O Lord, almighty God, should in all places give thanks unto thee, and specially at this time praise thee, for Christ our Passover lamb is offered for us. He is the true Lamb of God, which hath taken away the sin of the world, who by his temporal death hath destroyed our eternal death; and when he rose again, he hath brought life again. The day before, when Jesus Christ would suffer, he took the bread into his holy and worthy hands, and lifted up his eyes to heaven unto thee, God, his almighty Father, and said thanks unto thee, and blessed it, and brake it, and gave it to his disciples, saying: Take and eat ye all thereof. This is my body, which is given for you for the forgiveness of sins. *Now the choir beginneth to sing: "Jesus Christus, unser Heiland". One verse thereof.*

Note.

- **The Preface** is the Easter Preface: "To praise thee indeed, O Lord, at all times, but chiefly on this day more gloriously, when Christ our passover was sacrificed. For he is the very Lamb that hath taken away the sins of the world; who by dying hath destroyed our death, and by rising again hath restored our life".
  - The manuscript breaks off before the *Et ideo* (And therefore) and the Sanctus (Sehling: "The text breaks off at this point").
  - "Is offered for us" keeps *immolatus est* (was sacrificed; 1 Cor 5:7).
- **The bread-word** is Müntzer's *Qui pridie* (Who the day before), with "in forgiveness of sins" added to the bread.
- **Separate consecration.** Only the bread is consecrated now. The cup is consecrated after the communion of the bread (§7.11.4), as Luther had suggested.

7.11.3 Exhortation, *Fili Dei vivi*, *Domine non sum dignus*

Thereafter the priest turneth with the body of Christ to the people. And the communicants seat themselves all in a row before the altar to receive the sacrament. And the priest maketh an exhortation and saith, holding the body of Christ in his hand: Good friends, Christ our Saviour hath left us at his last departing a glorious jewel, to wit his body and blood, for a spiritual medicine and food, whereby we shall remember him; through which body and blood he hath set up for us an only testament of salvation, and confirmed the same testament of his flesh and blood with his bitter passion. And as often as we feel ourselves burdened with sins, and hunger and thirst after this food and after this drink, we shall receive it with a thorough and firm faith. And as often as we take it unto us, we shall be mindful to give him thanks and praise for his bitter passion, for his benefit, and that this

food may be helpful and comfortable unto us unto everlasting life. Amen. Say after me with inward heart: O Lord Jesu Christ, thou Son of the living God, who by the Father's will, through the working together of the Holy Ghost, hast by thy bitter death made the world alive again through faith: deliver us poor children of Adam, by this thy holy body and innocent blood, from all our iniquities and wickednesses, and grant us that we may at all times follow thy commandments obediently with desire and love, and never be separated from thee. Amen. O Lord, I am not worthy by my merit of thy worthy body and blood; but make me worthy by thy divine promise, make me whole by thy wholesome word. Amen.

Note.

- **The priest holds the host** during the exhortation. The exhortation takes the place of the Canon's remembrance.
- ***Fili Dei vivi*** is the Strasbourg and Döber German text (§7.5.1, §7.8.8), said after the priest by the communicants. Three phrases are added:
  - "through faith" (the world is made alive through faith);
  - "us poor children of Adam";
  - "with desire and love".
- ***Domine, non sum dignus.*** The Roman text is "Lord, I am not worthy that thou shouldest come under my roof: but speak the word only, and my soul shall be healed" (Mt 8:8). It was said by the priest, and by the people before communion. The Kiel text changes it:
  - It drops the centurion's roof.
  - It makes the worthiness a question of merit ("through my merit").
  - It asks that Christ's "divine promise" make the communicant worthy.
  - "make me blessed through thy wholesome word" keeps *sed tantum dic verbo, et sanabitur* (but speak the word only, and [my soul] shall be healed).

7.11.4 Communion of the bread; the cup-word and communion of the cup; blessing

Now the priest distributeth the body of Christ to the communicants, and the choir beginneth the second verse thus: "Dass wir des nimmer vergessen, gab etc." (That we might never forget it, he gave etc.), and singeth so long till the body of Christ is distributed. Thereafter the choir is silent. And the priest beginneth further to consecrate the blood of Christ, and saith: In like manner, when they had eaten, he took the cup into his holy and worthy hands, and said thanks unto thee, and blessed it, and gave it to his disciples, saying: Take and drink ye all thereout. This is the cup of my blood, of the new and everlasting testament, which is shed for you and for many for the forgiveness of sins. As often as ye do this, do it in my remembrance. *Now the priest giveth the communicants the blood of Christ, and the choir singeth "Jesus Christus unser", or the song of praise "Gott sei gelobet und gebenedeiet", etc., and singeth so long till the blood of Christ is distributed. Thereafter the priest turneth again to the people and saith:* The Lord be with you. *And concludeth the Mass with a collect. And after the collect the priest saith once more:* The Lord be with you. *Thereafter he readeth this blessing written hereafter over the people, and saith, Numbers the sixth chapter:* The Lord bless you and keep you. The Lord make his face shine upon you and be gracious unto you. The Lord lift up his countenance upon you and give you peace, through Christ our Lord. *The choir answereth:* Amen. *Thereafter a psalm is sung, wherewith the Mass is concluded.*

Note.

- **"to consecrate the blood of Christ".** The rubric calls the cup-word a consecration.
- **The cup-word** is Müntzer's *Simili modo* (In like manner), but "testament" (not "covenant"), and without *mysterium fidei* (the mystery of faith).
- **No Our Father, no *Pax*, no *Agnus Dei*.** The Our Father is said with the Creed and the Verba on weekdays without communicants, and at the communion of the sick.

7.12 Brandenburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1540

Church order of the Elector Joachim II, 1540. Sehling 3, Mark Brandenburg Nr. 3, pp. 67–71.

The order is conservative. The Latin chants stay. The offertory chant stays. The Preface and Sanctus are sung in Latin. The Verba are sung aloud in German. The prayers the priest said before communion (*Domine Iesu Christe qui dixisti*, *Fili Dei vivi*, *Perceptio*) and after it (*Corpus tuum*, *Quod ore sumpsimus*) are kept in Latin.

In the Canon's own place, under the Sanctus, the priest says four new German collects. For the Pfalz-Neuburg version of these, Sehling notes: "These prayers are set in the place of the intercessory prayers said in the Roman Mass partly before, partly after the consecration".

The order's rationale (p. 67) is given before the Mass:

The words of consecration shall also be sung or spoken openly after the Preface, as this also hath been customary in the Church of old [...]. Whence may be gathered with what ground such words may be forbidden to the laity: only for this cause, that it was perhaps feared they might in time become aware thereby, and find out, that the sacrament of the cup belonged to them as well as to the priests; and perhaps besides discover the unfitness of their Canon, whereon they have set well-nigh all salvation, and yet read the same secretly [...].

7.12.1 Creed, offertory, Preface, Sanctus

Thereupon the priest shall sing Credo in unum Deum; the Patrem shall be sung in cathedrals and collegiate churches in Latin, but in the parishes in German, "Wir glauben all an einen Gott" (We all believe in one God). Thereupon the priest shall sing Dominus vobiscum without Oremus; thereupon the chant which heretofore was kept for the offertory shall be sung; thereupon the priest shall sing the customary Preface, and next the Latin Sanctus, all sung in Latin. Under the Sanctus the priest shall pray the following prayer in German.

Note.

- **The offertory.** "*Dominus vobiscum* without *Oremus*" keeps the greeting before the offertory but drops the *Oremus* that led into the offertory prayers. The offertory chant itself survives ("the chant that was formerly kept for the offertory"). No offertory prayers are said.
- **In villages.** On p. 71 the order adds that "in the small towns ... and in the villages" the offertory "of the Sunday or of the feasts" may be replaced by a German psalm after the sermon: "thereupon shall follow the Latin Preface, the Sanctus, the communion and further the conclusion".
- **The Preface.** "The customary Preface" is the Latin Preface of the day. It is not printed.

7.12.2 The four collects under the Sanctus (in place of the Canon's intercessions)

For the magistrates. Merciful heavenly Father, in whose hands standeth all power and authority of men, ordained of thee for the punishment of evildoers and the protection of the godly, in whose hands also stand all the rights and laws of all lands: we beseech thee, be gracious unto our lord the Emperor, all kings and princes, especially unto our prince and lord of the land N., and unto the council and rulers of this city and all lawful magistrates, that they may rightly bear the temporal sword which thou hast committed unto them. Overshadow them with the power of the Highest; enlighten them and keep them in thy divine name; let them love thy divine word from the heart and hold fast thereto, and in no wise suffer it to be persecuted. Give them, dear Lord, wisdom and understanding and a peaceable government, that they may rule and defend all their subjects in the truth and righteousness that is well-pleasing unto thee. Also, my dear God, prolong their life according to thy will; and forasmuch as the judgement is thine and they sit in thy stead, give them grace so to rule that thy holy name may be hallowed and praised through them, from henceforth even for ever. This help them the Lord Jesus Christ, thy beloved Son. Amen.

Another. O almighty, gracious God and Father of our Lord Jesus Christ, who hast earnestly commanded us that we should pray thee for labourers into thine harvest, that is, for right and true preachers of thy word: we beseech thy bottomless mercy that thou wouldest send us right and true teachers and ministers of thy divine word, and give thy wholesome word into their heart and into their mouth, that they may faithfully perform thy commandment and preach nothing that is contrary to thy holy word; to the end that we, being by thy heavenly, eternal word admonished, taught, fed, comforted and strengthened, may do that which is well-pleasing unto thee and profitable unto us. Give, O Lord, unto thy holy Christian Church thy Spirit and divine wisdom, that thy word may run and grow among us and be preached with all boldness, as it becometh, and that thy holy Christian congregation may be bettered thereby; that we may serve thee with steadfast faith and continue in the knowledge of thy name unto the end; through our Lord, etc.

Another. Almighty God and everlasting Father, a King of glory and a Lord of heaven and of earth, by whose Spirit all things are governed, by whose providence all things are ordered; thou art a God of peace, from whom alone unity cometh unto us: we beseech thee through our Lord Jesus Christ that thou wouldest forgive us our sins and endue us with thy divine peace and unity, that we may serve thy name in fear and trembling, and that thou mayest be praised of us evermore. Amen.

Merciful God and heavenly Father, whose mercy hath no end, who art longsuffering, gracious and of great goodness and faithfulness, and forgivest all iniquity, transgression and sin: we have, alas, sinned with our fathers, we have done amiss and dealt wickedly and oftentimes provoked thee to wrath; against thee only have we sinned and done evil in thy sight. But, Lord, remember not against us our former iniquities; let thy mercy speedily be great upon us, for we are brought very low. Help us, O God of our salvation, for the glory of thy name; deliver us and forgive us our sins, through thy Son Jesus Christ. Amen.

Note. The texts and translations are the same as in `general_prayers.db` (family L). Sehling traces the collects for the ministers and for peace to Brandenburg-Nürnberg 1533. The one for the magistrates is an expanded form of the Nürnberg collect. The penitential fourth, woven from Ps 106:6, Ps 51:4 and Ps 79:8–9, stands where the Canon's prayers for forgiveness stood (*Hanc igitur*'s *ab aeterna damnatione nos eripi* [that we be delivered from eternal damnation], the *Nobis quoque peccatoribus* [To us sinners also]).

7.12.3 The Verba, sung, with elevation

Thereafter the words of consecration shall be sung in German, and the elevation made, as followeth: Our Lord Jesus, in the night in which he was betrayed, took the bread, gave thanks unto his heavenly Father, blessed it, and brake it, and gave it to his disciples, and said: Take and eat, this is my body, which is given for you; this do in remembrance of me. *Here, with a slight inclination, lift it up reverently on high. Then take the cup with both hands, and say:* Likewise also he took the cup after the supper, gave thanks and blessed it, and gave it to his disciples, and said: Drink ye all of it, this is my blood of the new testament, which is shed for you and for many for the remission of sins; this do, as oft as ye drink it, in remembrance of me. *Lift the cup on high. After the elevation, in cathedrals and collegiate churches a Latin chant shall be sung, as the responsory Tua est potentia, etc.; but in the parishes a German song: "Es wolt uns Gott genädig sein", or "Sei Lob und Dank mit hohem Preis".*

Note.

- **The Verba.** They are the Pauline and Lutheran form. "Giveth thanks to his heavenly Father" keeps an echo of *tibi gratias agens* (giving thanks to thee).
- **Rubrics.** The Latin rubrics are those of the missal: *elevat … reverenter* (he elevateth … reverently), *accipit calicem ambabus manibus* (he taketh the chalice with both hands).
- **The chant.** The Latin responsory after the elevation takes the place of the *Benedictus* sung at the elevation.

The elevation in the order of the Mass is treated in Chapter 2, §2.11, and as a mark of the feast in Chapter 12, §12.10.6.

7.12.4 Our Father and the Peace

Thereupon the Pater noster shall be sung in German, as followeth. Let us pray, as the Lord Christ Jesus hath commanded us, that out of right confidence and trust we may be bold to say: Our Father, which art in heaven, hallowed be thy name, thy kingdom come, thy will be done, as in heaven, so in earth; give us this day our daily bread, and forgive us our debts, as we forgive our debtors; and lead us not into temptation, but deliver us from evil: for thine is the kingdom, and the power, and the glory, for ever. *Let all the people say, Amen. Turning himself to the people he singeth:* The peace of the Lord be with you all. *Let all the people say, Amen.*

Note. "As the Lord Christ Jesus hath commanded us, that we … may say" recasts *Praeceptis salutaribus moniti … audemus dicere* (Admonished by saving precepts … we make bold to say).

There is no embolism. *Pax Domini sit semper vobiscum* (The peace of the Lord be always with you) is kept, with the people answering *Amen* where the Roman response is *Et cum spiritu tuo* (And with thy spirit).

7.12.5 *Agnus Dei* and the priest's three prayers before communion (Latin)

O Lamb of God, that takest away the sins of the world, have mercy upon us. O Lamb of God, that takest away the sins of the world, have mercy upon us. O Lamb of God, that takest away the sins of the world, grant us peace. *The Agnus Dei shall also be sung in Latin. Bow thyself.* O Lord Jesus Christ, who saidst unto thine apostles, My peace I give unto you, my peace I leave with you: regard not my sins, but the faith of thy Church; and vouchsafe to pacify, keep, help and govern her according to thy will; who with God the Father and the Holy Ghost livest and reignest God, world without end. Amen. *Bowing, let him say:* O Lord Jesus Christ, Son of the living God, who by the will of the Father, the Holy Ghost working with thee, hast by thine own death given life to the world: deliver us by this thy most holy body and blood from all our iniquities and all our evils; and make us ever to obey

thy commandments, and suffer us never to be separated from thy mercy for evermore. Who livest and reignest God, world without end. Amen. *Another prayer.* Let the sacrament of thy body, O Lord Jesus Christ, which we unworthy desire to receive, not turn to us unto judgement and condemnation; but of thy goodness let it profit us unto the defence of mind and body, and unto the obtaining of healing; who livest and reignest with God the Father in the unity of the Holy Ghost, God, world without end. Amen.

Note. These are the three prayers the priest said before his communion. Pfalz-Neuburg 1543 (note 20–21) reports that in 1540 two were said, the third being an alternative to the second.

1. ***Domine Iesu Christe, qui dixisti.***
   - The two halves of John 14:27 are inverted: "do … relinquo" (I give … I leave), where the Roman text has *Pacem relinquo vobis, pacem meam do vobis* (Peace I leave with you, my peace I give unto you).
   - The verbs "pacificare custodire adiuvare et regere" (to keep in peace, guard, help and govern) are those of the Canon's *Te igitur* (Thee therefore; *pacificare, custodire, adunare et regere*), with *adiuvare* (help) for *adunare* (unite). The Tridentine text has only *pacificare et coadunare* (to keep in peace and unite).
2. ***Fili Dei vivi.***
   - The Roman singular (*libera me … meis … fac me … inhaerere … a te*) is made plural and congregational.
   - *Inhaerere* becomes *obedire*.
   - *A te numquam separari* (never to be separated from thee) becomes *a tua misericordia nunquam in perpetuum separari* (never for ever to be separated from thy mercy).
   - This petition, "Deliver us by this thy most holy body and blood", is not the embolism *Libera nos, quaesumus* (Deliver us, we beseech thee).
3. ***Perceptio corporis tui*** appears as *Sacramentum corporis tui* (The sacrament of thy body).
   - It is plural, and *praesumo* (I presume) becomes *cupimus* (we desire).
   - *Tutamen* (defence) stands for *tutamentum* (defence). The stray *tui* (thy) after *indigni* (unworthy) is as printed.

7.12.6 The exhortation (Osiander, Nürnberg 1533)

Then turning himself to the people let him read this exhortation. Dearly beloved in God, forasmuch as we will now consider and keep the supper of our Lord Jesus Christ, wherein he hath given us his flesh for a meat and his blood for a drink, therewith to strengthen faith, we ought rightly every one with great diligence to examine himself, as the holy Paul exhorteth us; for this holy sacrament is given for a special comfort and strength unto the poor troubled consciences that confess their sins, fear God's wrath and death, and are hungry and thirsty after righteousness. But when we examine ourselves, and every one goeth into his own conscience, as the holy Paul teacheth us, we shall surely find nothing else but all manner of horrible sin, and death, which we have deserved with sin; and yet we cannot in any wise help ourselves out thereof. Therefore hath our dear Lord Jesus Christ had mercy upon us, and for our sins' sake is become man, to the end that he might fulfil the law and all the will of God for us and for our good, and take upon himself and suffer death and all that we had deserved with our sins, for us and for our deliverance. And that we might steadfastly believe this, and through faith live joyfully in his will, he took after the supper the bread, gave thanks, brake it, and said: Take and eat, this is my body, which is given for you; that is, that I am become man, and all that I do and suffer is all your own, done for you and for your good; for a sure token and witness whereof I give you my body for meat. Likewise he took also the cup, and said: Take and drink ye all of this, this is the cup of the new testament in my blood, which is shed for you and for many for the remission of sins; as oft as ye do this, ye shall remember me thereby; that is, forasmuch as I have taken your cause upon me and laden your sins upon myself, I will offer myself unto death for sin, shed my blood, obtain grace and forgiveness of sins, and so set up a new testament, wherein sins are forgiven and shall be remembered no more for ever; for a sure token and witness whereof I give you my blood to drink. Whosoever now eateth thus of this bread and drinketh of this cup, and firmly believeth these words which he heareth of Christ and these signs which he receiveth of Christ, he dwelleth in the Lord Christ and Christ in him, and shall live for ever. Hereby shall we now remember him and show forth his death, namely that he died for our sins and rose again for our justification, and give him thanks therefor; every one take up his cross and follow him, and according to his commandment love one another, as he hath loved us: for we are all one bread and one body, seeing we are all partakers of one bread and drink of one cup.

Note. This is Osiander's Nürnberg exhortation (§7.8.7) as revised for Brandenburg-Nürnberg 1533 (Sehling 11, 195). It comes after the Latin priest's prayers and immediately before the distribution. *Darbei dabei* is a doublet in the print.

7.12.7 Communion

Thereupon shall be begun the responsory Discubuit Jesus in Latin; and if the communicants were many, so that it might not suffice therewith, one shall begin to sing to the people in German "Gott sei gelobet" (God be praised) or "Jesus Christus, unser Heiland" (Jesus Christ, our Saviour); one of which songs, even though the Discubuit suffice, shall nevertheless be sung after the communion. Now the communicants approach, and when the Lord's body is reached to them, let the priest say: Take and eat, this is the body of Christ, which is given for thee. *At the cup let the deacon say:* Take and drink, this is the blood of the new testament, which is shed for thy sins.

Note. The communion formula is Lutheran, not Roman. *Corpus Domini nostri … custodiat* (The body of our Lord … preserve) is not used. The Latin responsory *Discubuit Jesus* (Jesus sat at table; from the Maundy Thursday office) serves as the communion chant.

7.12.8 Thanksgiving and the two Latin ablution prayers

Then turning to the people let him read the following thanksgiving. Let us pray. O almighty, everlasting God, we give praise and thanks unto thy divine bounty that thou hast fed us and given us to drink with the wholesome flesh and blood of thine only Son Jesus Christ our Lord; and we humbly beseech thee that thou wouldest work in us by thy Holy Spirit, that as we have received this holy sacrament with the mouth, so we may also with firm faith apprehend and for ever retain thy divine grace, forgiveness of sins, union with Christ and everlasting life, which are therein set forth and promised. We thank thee also, almighty God, that thou hast refreshed us through this wholesome gift of the body and blood of Christ thy Son; and we beseech thy mercy that thou wouldest let the same prosper in us unto strong faith toward thee and unto fervent love among us all; through our Lord Jesus Christ thy Son, who with thee in eternity [*read*: unity] of the Holy Ghost liveth and reigneth, true God, ever and eternally. Amen. *Then let him bow and say:* May thy body, O Lord, which we sinners have received, and the cup which we have drunk, cleave unto our inward parts; and grant, O almighty God, that no stain of sin may remain there where thy pure and holy sacraments have entered; through the same Christ our Lord. What we have received with the mouth, O Lord, may we take with a pure mind, and may it be unto us an everlasting remedy; through Christ our Lord.

Note.

- **The German thanksgiving.** It comes from Brandenburg-Nürnberg 1533. "In eternity of the Holy Ghost" is evidently a slip for "in unity"; Pfalz-Neuburg reads *einigkeit* (unity).
- **The two Latin prayers.** They are the priest's prayers at the ablutions.
  - *Corpus tuum* (Thy body) is in the plural, with the wording "that no stain of sin may remain there, where … pure and holy sacraments have entered". The Tridentine text reads "that no stain of sin may remain in me, whom pure and holy sacraments have refreshed".
  - *Quod ore sumpsimus* (What we have taken with our mouth) lacks *et de munere temporali* (and from a temporal gift). Pfalz-Neuburg restores it.
- **The blessing.** Sehling notes that the 1540 and 1542 prints end here. The blessing printed in Mylius's edition is not in them.

7.13 Calenberg-Göttingen, *Kirchenordnung*, 1542

Church order of Duchess Elisabeth for the principality of Calenberg-Göttingen, drawn up by Antonius Corvinus, 1542. Sehling 6, III, pp. 813–817 (`eko.db` doc 2036), with the Masses for the church year on pp. 819–834 (doc 2037).

The Sacrament is taken from Brandenburg 1540 (§7.12), put into German throughout:

- the collect for the magistrates prayed by the priest under the Sanctus;
- the *Pax Domini* (The peace of the Lord);
- the Brandenburg thanksgiving.

To these Göttingen adds a *custodiat* (preserve) at the distribution, which Brandenburg lacks.

Brandenburg's Latin *Domine Iesu Christe, qui dixisti* (O Lord Jesus Christ, who saidst) becomes a German postcommunion collect. The proper Masses for the church year take many of their introits, collects, readings and Prefaces from Müntzer's German Mass (§7.4; Radical Reformation). Sehling's notes to doc 2037 say so at each place, e.g. p. 821 n. 84: "Compare the same Preface in Müntzer, German evangelical Mass of 1524". The route is given in Sehling's note 26 (p. 812): "Corvinus has here, by way of the

Erfurt church offices, taken over in part the altar chants and liturgical texts of Thomas Müntzer". The Erfurt *Kirchenamt* of 1525 added a Trinity Mass to Müntzer's five, and a second Erfurt print added the Ascension, the Sacrament and the Apostles.

7.13.1 Offertory, Preface, Sanctus, and the collect under the Sanctus

Thereafter the priest goeth again before the altar, and the choir singeth in the meantime: "Es wollt uns Gott genädig sein", etc., or "Gott der Vater wohn uns bei", etc. Thereafter the priest singeth: The Lord be with you! *The choir answereth:* And with thy spirit. *Thereafter followeth the offertory. In the stead of the offertory a German psalm shall be sung with the congregation.* Praise be to God from everlasting to everlasting. Amen. The Lord be with you, and with thy spirit. Lift up your hearts! We lift them up unto the Lord. Let us give thanks unto the Lord our God! That is meet and is right! Verily this is meet and right and wholesome that we should give thanks unto thee, holy Lord, almighty Father, everlasting God, through Christ our Lord, who is the true Passover lamb; he is verily the Lamb that beareth the sin of the world, who hath destroyed our death by his dying, and hath won life by his rising again. Therefore we sing with his angels and archangels a song of praise to thine honour, saying without end: *The Sanctus.* Isaiah the prophet, it befell him that he in the spirit saw the Lord sitting upon a high throne in bright splendour; the hem of his garment filled all the choir. […] Holy is God, the Lord of Sabaoth! Holy is God, the Lord of Sabaoth! Holy is God, the Lord of Sabaoth! His glory hath filled the whole world. […] *Under the Sanctus let the priest pray one of these prayers or collects. For the magistrates.* Merciful heavenly Father, in whose hands stand the power and authority of all men, ordained by thee for the punishment of evil-doers and for the protection of the godly; in whose hands also stand all the rights and laws of all lands: we beseech thee, be gracious unto our emperor, all kings and princes, specially unto our sovereign lady and the young lordship, the council and governors of this city and all orderly authority, that they may rightly bear the temporal sword which thou hast committed unto them. Overshadow them with the power of the Most High, enlighten them and keep them in thy divine name! Let them love thy divine word from the heart and hold fast thereby, and never suffer the same to be persecuted. Give them, dear Lord, wisdom and understanding and a peaceable government, that they may govern and defend all their subjects in the truth and righteousness that is pleasing unto thee. Also, my dear God, prolong their life according to thy will. And because the judgement is thine and they sit in thy stead, give them grace so to govern that thy holy name may be hallowed and praised through them from henceforth for evermore. This help them the Lord Jesus Christ, thy beloved Son. Amen.

Note.

- **"In place of the offertory".** The offertory keeps its name and place ("Thereafter followeth the offertory") as a German hymn.
- **"God be praised from eternity to eternity. Amen."** This is *Per omnia saecula saeculorum. Amen*, the end of the Secret, sung before the Preface dialogue. Müntzer has it in the same place as "through all eternity of eternity. Amen" (§7.4.1).
- **The Preface** is the Easter Preface. Sehling's note refers it to the Roman Easter Preface.
- **The Sanctus** is Luther's German Sanctus (*Deutsche Messe*).
- **The collect** is the first of Brandenburg's four collects under the Sanctus (§7.12.2), adapted to a duchess-regent ("our princess of the land and the young lordship"). As there, it stands in the place of the Canon's intercessions. The Masses for the church year (doc 2037) repeat it or give other collects "which the priest prayeth under the Sanctus".

7.13.2 Our Father, Verba, communion with the *custodiat*, the Peace

Let us pray, as the Lord Christ Jesus hath commanded us, that out of right confidence and trust we may be bold to say: Our Father, which art in heaven, hallowed be thy name, thy kingdom come, thy will be done, as in heaven, so in earth. Give us this day our daily bread, and forgive us our debts, as we forgive our debtors! And lead us not into temptation, but deliver us from evil; for thine is the kingdom, and the power, and the glory, for ever. Amen. *The words of consecration.* Our Lord Jesus, in the night in which he was betrayed, took the bread, gave thanks unto his heavenly Father, and brake it, and gave it to his disciples, and said: Take and eat, this is my body, which is given for you; this do in remembrance of me. After the same manner he took also the cup after the supper, gave thanks, and gave it to his disciples, and said: Drink ye all of it, this is my blood of the new testament, which is shed for you and for many for the forgiveness of sins; this do, as oft as ye drink it, in remembrance of me! *Hereafter the priest shall give the sacrament to the people and say:* Take and eat, this is the body of Christ, which is given for thee; the same preserve thy soul unto everlasting life. Amen. Take and drink, this is the blood of the new testament, which is shed for thy sins; the same strengthen thy soul unto everlasting life. Amen. *And meanwhile let the Discubuit be sung, or "Jesus Christus unser Heiland", etc., or "Gott sei gelobet". When the last go up, let the choir close with the same verses. Thereafter let the priest sing:* The peace of the Lord be with you! *The choir singeth:* And with thy spirit!

Note.

- **The Our Father.** Brandenburg's recast *Praeceptis salutaribus* (Taught by saving precepts; §7.12.4) is kept.
- **The *custodiat*.** "who preserve thy soul unto everlasting life" is the *custodiat* (preserve). "that strengthen thy soul" varies it for the cup. Brandenburg's own formula ("Take and eat …") has no *custodiat*.
- **The *Pax Domini*** follows the communion, as a greeting of peace before the thanksgiving. The Roman response is kept.
- **The communion chant.** *Discubuit Iesus* is the responsory that Brandenburg also prescribes (§7.12.7).

7.13.3 Thanksgiving, *Agnus Dei*, and *Qui dixisti* as the final collect

Hereupon followeth the thanksgiving, which shall be made in all Masses after the communion is done; and the priest turneth to the people and saith: O almighty, everlasting God, we give praise and thanks unto thy divine bounty, that thou hast fed and given us to drink with the wholesome flesh and blood of thine only Son Jesus Christ, our Lord; and we humbly beseech thee that thou wouldest work in us by thy Holy Ghost, that as we have received this holy sacrament with the mouth, so we may also lay hold on thy divine grace, forgiveness of sins, union with Christ and everlasting life, which are therein shown and promised, with firm faith, and keep them for ever. We thank thee also, almighty God, that thou hast refreshed us through the wholesome gift of thy body and blood; and we beseech thy mercy that thou wouldest let it prosper unto us to strong faith toward thee and to fervent love toward us all; through our Lord Jesus Christ, thy Son, who with thee in the eternity of the Holy Ghost liveth and reigneth, true God, ever and everlastingly. Amen. Go in peace! *The Agnus Dei.* O Lamb of God, unspotted, slain upon the tree of the cross, found patient at all times, although thou wast despised; all sins hast thou borne, else must we have despaired; have mercy upon us, O Jesu! *Hereupon followeth the collect, which the priest singeth.* O Lord Jesu Christ, who hast said to thine apostles: My peace I give unto you, my peace I leave with you!, vouchsafe not to remember our sins, but look upon the faith of thy congregation; which vouchsafe thou to keep in peace, to preserve and to govern; who with the Father and the Holy Ghost, true God, rulest and reignest for ever. Amen. *Hereafter followeth the blessing:* The Lord bless thee and keep thee! The Lord make his face shine upon thee and be gracious unto thee! The Lord lift up his countenance upon thee and give thee peace! *The priest singeth:* Let us praise the Lord, alleluia! *The choir:* Give thanks unto the Lord, alleluia! *Let him conclude with the Da pacem, "Verleih uns Frieden", etc., with the collect.*

Note.

- **The thanksgiving** is Brandenburg's, made of two parts (§7.12.8). Brandenburg's Latin ablution prayers after it are dropped.
- **"Go in peace!"** is *Ite, missa est* (Go, it is the dismissal) in German.
- **The *Agnus Dei*** is Decius' hymn, moved after the thanksgiving.
- **The final collect is *Domine Iesu Christe, qui dixisti* in German.** It is the priest's prayer for the peace of the Church, said in the Roman Mass before the kiss of peace and kept by Brandenburg in Latin before communion (§7.12.5). Sehling's note: "The following collect is contained in Latin in the church order for the Mark of Brandenburg of 1540 … Compare the Roman Missal … (Ordo Missae, prayer for peace)". Here it becomes a collect sung aloud to close the Mass.
  - The verbs "keep, preserve and govern" follow Brandenburg's *pacificare custodire … regere* (to keep in peace, guard … govern; §7.12.5).
  - "the faith of thy congregation" puts "congregation" for *ecclesiae tuae* (of thy Church).
- **The Easter *Benedicamus*.** "Let us praise the Lord, alleluia / Give thanks unto the Lord, alleluia" is the Easter *Benedicamus Domino, alleluia / Deo gratias, alleluia* (Let us bless the Lord, alleluia / Thanks be to God, alleluia).

7.13.4 From the Masses for the church year

The proper Masses (doc 2037) end with proper collects in the same slot. For Whitsun it is Müntzer's closing prayer (Sehling: "Collect from Müntzer's German evangelical Mass of 1524"), which is a German version of the Roman Whitsun postcommunion *Sancti Spiritus, Domine, corda nostra mundet infusio: et sui roris intima aspersione fecundet* (May the infusion of the Holy Spirit, O Lord, cleanse our hearts, and make them fruitful by the inward sprinkling of his dew; §7.4.4):

O Lord, grant us the grace of the Holy Ghost, that the dew of thy goodness may make the ground of our heart fruitful by its sprinkling […].

7.14 Pfalz-Neuburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1543

Church order of Count Palatine Ottheinrich, 1543. Sehling 13, I.2, pp. 70–76 (Mass). Canon critique: pp. 64–65, Appendix 7.A.

Sehling notes that the Mass follows Brandenburg-Nürnberg 1533, with additions from Brandenburg 1540. Its shape differs from both in three ways:

1. **No Preface.** Osiander's exhortation is moved to *before* the consecration.
2. **A new prayer over the elements.** Before the Verba the priest says Osiander's newly written prayer over the hosts and cup. In it he "brings before thy divine majesty these thy gifts, bread and wine". It serves as both an offertory and an epiclesis.
3. **The Sanctus after the Verba.** The Sanctus follows the Verba, and the Brandenburg collects are said under it.

After the Our Father, the Brandenburg Latin prayers follow. There are two changes to them: *Fili Dei vivi* (Son of the living God) reads **"hast given life to thy Church"**, and *Sacramentum corporis* (The sacrament of the body) adds **"and of the blood"**.

7.14.1 Creed, sermon, and the exhortation before the Lord's Supper

After the Gospel the priest shall sing the Credo and the choir the Patrem in Latin; or, where there is no choir, the priest may himself sing or say it, and meanwhile let the people sing the German song "Wir glauben all an einen Gott". […] Where now one preacheth during the Mass, the priest shall forthwith after the sermon go again to the altar; and, that the people may the more diligently and devoutly perceive all that followeth, he, or one of the ministers if there be any, shall read the following exhortation toward the people. Exhortation before the Supper. Dearly beloved in God! Forasmuch as we will now consider and keep the holy supper of our Lord Jesus Christ, wherein he hath given us his flesh for a meat and his blood for a drink, therewith to strengthen faith, we ought rightly every one with great diligence to examine himself, as the holy Paul exhorteth us; for this holy sacrament is given for a special comfort and strength unto the poor, troubled consciences which feel and confess their sins, fear God's wrath and death, and are hungry and thirsty after righteousness. But when we examine ourselves, and every one goeth into his own conscience, as the holy Paul teacheth us, we shall surely find nothing else but all manner of horrible sin, and death, which we have deserved with sin; and yet we cannot in any wise help ourselves out thereof. Therefore hath our dear Lord Jesus Christ had mercy upon us, and for our sins' sake is become man, to the end that he might fulfil the law and all the will of God for us and for our good, and take upon himself and suffer death and all that we had deserved with our sins, for us and for our deliverance. And to the end that we might steadfastly believe this, and through faith live joyfully in his will, he took after the supper the bread, gave thanks, brake it, and said: Take and eat! This is my body, which is given for you; that is: that I am become man, and all that I do and suffer is all your own, done for you and for your good. For a sure token and witness whereof I give you my body for meat. Likewise he took also the cup, and said: Take and drink ye all of this! This is the cup of the new testament in my blood. As oft as ye do this, ye shall remember me thereby. That is: forasmuch as I have taken your cause upon me and laden your sins upon myself, I will offer myself unto death for sin, shed my blood, obtain grace and forgiveness of sins, and so set up a new testament, wherein sins are forgiven and shall be remembered no more for ever. For a sure token and witness whereof I give you my blood to drink. Whosoever now eateth thus of this bread and drinketh of this cup, and firmly believeth these words which he heareth of Christ and these signs which he receiveth of Christ, he dwelleth in the Lord Christ and Christ in him, and shall live for ever. Hereby shall we now remember him and show forth his death, namely that he died for our sins and rose again for our justification, and give him thanks therefor; every one take up his cross and follow him, and according to his commandment love one another, as he hath loved us: for we are all one bread and one body, seeing we are all partakers of one bread and drink of one cup.

Note. This is the Brandenburg text (§7.12.6), which Sehling traces from 1540 back to 1533. It is moved from before the distribution to before the consecration. There are two changes:

- **The cup word** stops at "in my blood". It lacks "which is shed for you and for many for the remission of sins".
- **The consciences** "feel and confess" their sins .

7.14.2 Osiander's prayer over the hosts and cup (offertory and epiclesis)

After this exhortation the priest shall say this following prayer over the hosts and the cup, which shall be set upon the altar according to the number and occasion of the persons that will go to the holy sacrament: Prayer. Lord Jesus Christ, thou only true Son of the living God, who hast given thy body for us all into the bitter death, and shed thy blood for the forgiveness of our sins, and hast moreover commanded all thy disciples to eat the same thy body and to drink the same thy blood, and therewith to remember thy death: we bring before thy divine majesty these thy gifts, bread and wine, and beseech thee that thou wouldest, by thy divine grace, goodness and power, hallow and bless the same, and make that this bread be thy body and this wine thy

blood, and let them prosper unto everlasting life unto all them that eat and drink thereof; who with God the Father in the unity of the Holy Ghost livest and reignest ever and eternally. Amen.

Note. Sehling calls this an offertory prayer newly written by Osiander, and cites Graff's study of the epiclesis in Reformation orders. Addressed to Christ, not to the Father, it gathers four parts of the Canon into one prayer said over the elements:

Osiander 1543	Roman source
"Lord Jesus Christ, thou only true Son of the living God"	*Domine Iesu Christe, Fili Dei vivi* (O Lord Jesus Christ, Son of the living God)
"We bring before thy divine majesty these thy gifts, bread and wine"	*Unde et memores* (Wherefore, mindful): *offerimus praeclarae maiestati tuae de tuis donis ac datis* (we offer unto thy excellent majesty, of thy gifts and bounties); also *Te igitur* (Thee therefore): *haec dona, haec munera* (these gifts, these presents)
"that thou wouldest … hallow, bless and make these, that this bread may be thy body and this wine thy blood"	*Quam oblationem* (Which oblation): *benedictam … facere digneris, ut nobis Corpus et Sanguis fiat* (vouchsafe to make … blessed, that it may become for us the Body and Blood)
"cause it to prosper unto everlasting life for all that eat and drink thereof"	*Supplices* (We humbly [beseech]): *ut quotquot ex hac altaris participatione … sumpserimus, omni benedictione caelesti et gratia repleamur* (that as many of us as by this partaking of the altar … shall receive may be filled with all heavenly benediction and grace)

It meets the demand of the critique printed earlier in the same order (Appendix 7.A) only half-way. The verb there objected to, *opfern* (offer), becomes *bringen … fur deine götliche majestat* (bring … before thy divine majesty), and the gifts are "thy gifts, bread and wine", not the body and blood.

7.14.3 The Verba, sung, with elevation

As soon as this prayer is ended he shall begin to sing the words of consecration, or to say them with a loud, well-audible voice, as he hath aforetime sung or said other chants, as hereafter followeth; and he shall take care that his gestures agree with the words; that is, when he singeth "He took the bread …", he shall also take the large host and hold it level with his breast until the words be ended. Likewise, when he singeth "He took the cup …", he shall do so with the cup also, as aforesaid. Our Lord Jesus, in the night in which he was betrayed, took the bread, gave thanks, and brake it, and gave it to his disciples, and said: Take and eat! This is my body, which is given for you. This do in remembrance of me! *Here he shall lift up the large host with bowed head and show it to the people; thereafter take also the cup and hold it, until he sing or say the following words:* Likewise also he took the cup after the supper, and gave thanks, and gave it to them, and said: Drink ye all of it! This is my blood of the new testament, which is shed for you and for many for the remission of sins. This do, as oft as ye drink it, in remembrance of me! *Here he shall lift up the cup also and show it to the people.*

Note. The Verba are sung to the Our Father tone, following Luther's suggestion in the *Formula missae* (Form of the Mass) and the Nürnberg melody of 1533. The large host is kept, a relic of the Roman fraction host. The elevation is kept, with a bowed head.

7.14.4 Sanctus with three collects

Thereafter the choir shall sing the Sanctus in Latin; or, where there is no choir, the priest may himself sing or say it, and in place thereof let the people sing a good German spiritual song; and under the same singing he shall meanwhile say these following prayers. There follow the prayers which the priest shall say under or after the Sanctus. For the temporal magistrates. Merciful heavenly Father, in whose hands standeth all power and authority of men, ordained of thee for the punishment of evildoers and the protection of the godly, in whose hands also stand all the rights and laws of all lands: we beseech thee, be gracious unto our lord the Emperor, all kings and princes, especially unto our prince and lord of the land N., and unto the council and rulers of this city and all lawful magistrates, that they may rightly bear the temporal sword which thou hast committed unto them. Overshadow them with the power of thy divine Majesty; enlighten them and keep them in thy divine name; let them love thy divine word from the heart and submit themselves thereto. Give them, dear Lord, wisdom and understanding and a peaceable government, that they may rule and defend all their subjects in the truth and righteousness that is well-pleasing unto thee. Also,

my dear God, prolong their life according to thy will; and forasmuch as the judgement is thine and they sit in thy stead, give them grace so to rule that thy holy name may be hallowed and praised through them, from henceforth even for ever. Amen.

For the ministers of the word. O almighty, gracious God and Father of our Lord Jesus Christ, who hath earnestly commanded us that we should pray thee for labourers into thine harvest: we beseech thy bottomless mercy that thou wouldest send us right and true teachers and ministers of thy divine word, and give thy wholesome word into their heart and mouth, that they may faithfully perform thy commandment and preach nothing that is contrary to thy holy word; to the end that we, being by thy heavenly, eternal word admonished, taught, fed, comforted and strengthened, may do that which is well-pleasing unto thee and profitable unto us. Give, O Lord, unto thy holy Christendom thy Spirit and divine wisdom, that thy word may run and grow among us and be preached with all boldness, as it becometh, and that thy holy Christian congregation may be bettered thereby; that we may serve thee with steadfast faith and continue in the knowledge of thy name unto the end.

For Christian unity. Merciful God and everlasting Father, a King of glory and a Lord of heaven and of earth, by whose Spirit all things are governed, by whose providence all things are ordered: thou art a God of peace, from whom all unity cometh unto us. We beseech thee that thou wouldest forgive us our sins and endue us with thy divine peace and unity, that we may serve thy name in fear and trembling for ever and ever, and thy divine Majesty be praised of us evermore; through our Lord Jesus Christ thy Son, who with thee in the unity of the Holy Ghost liveth and reigneth ever and eternally. Amen.

Note. These are Brandenburg's first three collects (§7.12.2), with two changes to the collect for the magistrates:

- **"Overshadow them with the power of thy divine majesty"** replaces "with the power of the most High". It removes the Marian echo of Luke 1:35.
- **"Submit themselves to the same"** replaces "hold fast thereto and not suffer it to be persecuted". The magistrates are to *submit* to the Word, not merely protect it.

Brandenburg's fourth, penitential collect is dropped. Sehling's note on this passage explains the placing: "These prayers are set in the place of the intercessory prayers said in the Roman Mass partly before, partly after the consecration. Elsewhere in evangelical church orders they were struck out without replacement, because they are founded on the sacrificial character of the Mass rejected by the Reformation." In other words, elsewhere the Canon's intercessions were cut without replacement, because they rest on the sacrificial character of the Mass.

7.14.5 Our Father and the Peace

When then the Sanctus or other singing is ended and these prayers are said, he shall sing the Our Father or say it with a loud voice, as hereafter followeth: Let us pray! Our Father, which art in heaven, hallowed be thy name. Thy kingdom come. Thy will be done, as in heaven, so in earth. Give us this day our daily bread. And forgive us our debts, as we forgive our debtors. And lead us not into temptation, but deliver us from evil: for thine is the kingdom, and the power, and the glory, for ever. *Choir:* Amen. *Thereafter let him turn to the people.* The peace of the Lord be with you all! *Choir:* Amen.

Note. Of *Praeceptis salutaribus* (Taught by saving precepts) only *Oremus* is left. There is no embolism.

7.14.6 *Agnus Dei* and the priest's three prayers (Latin)

Thereafter the choir, or, where there is no choir, the priest himself shall sing or else say the Agnus Dei, as the custom is, and meanwhile let the people again sing a good German spiritual song; and under the same the priest shall also say these following prayers. O Lamb of God, that takest away the sins of the world, have mercy upon us! O Lamb of God, that takest away the sins of the world, have mercy upon us! O Lamb of God, that takest away the sins of the world, grant us peace! O Lord Jesus Christ, who saidst unto thine apostles, My peace I give unto you, peace I leave with you: regard not my sins, but the faith of thy Church; and vouchsafe to pacify, keep, help and govern her according to thy will; who with God the Father and the Holy Ghost livest and reignest, God, world without end! Amen. *Another prayer:* O Lord Jesus Christ, Son of the living God, who by the will of the Father, the Holy Ghost working with thee, hast given life to thy Church: deliver us by this thy most holy body and blood from all iniquities and all our evils, and make us ever to obey thy commandments, and suffer us never to be separated from thy mercy for evermore; who livest and reignest, God, world without end! Amen. *Another prayer:* Let the sacrament of thy body and blood, O Lord Jesus Christ, which we unworthy desire to receive, not turn to us unto judgement and condemnation; but of thy goodness let it profit us unto the defence of mind and body, and unto the obtaining of healing; who livest and reignest with God the Father in the unity of the Holy Ghost, God, world without end! Amen.

Note. These are the Brandenburg prayers (§7.12.5), with three changes:

1. ***Fili Dei vivi.*** "by thine own death hast given life to the world" becomes **"hast given life to thy Church"**. The phrase about Christ's own death goes, and *the world* becomes *thy Church*.
2. ***Perceptio.*** "of thy Body *and Blood*" adds the cup, which fits communion in both kinds.
3. **The rubric.** All three may be said, each marked *Alia oratio* (Another prayer).

7.14.7 Communion

Thereafter all shall go to the sacrament who have announced themselves beforehand and have received the absolution; and the priest shall reach them the body of the Lord with these words: Take and eat! This is the body of Christ, which is given for thee. *Likewise, where there are ministers, the deacon shall reach the cup to them that have partaken of the body of Christ, and say thus:* Take and drink! This is the blood of the new testament, which is shed for thy sins. *But where there are no ministers, the priest shall first reach the body of the Lord to every one, and only thereafter the cup; and while this is done, the choir shall sing the communion in Latin, and if it were too short, other good Latin chant more, especially what is de coena Domini, as the responsory Discubuit Jesus. But where there is no choir, the congregation shall again be let sing a good German spiritual song, such as "Jesus Christus unser Heiland …" (Jesus Christ, our Saviour …), or else "Gott sei gelobet und gebenedeiet …" (God be praised and blessed …), or another song that befitteth the occasion of the time. When now every one hath received the holy sacrament, then shall the priest also receive it. And although he shall from the beginning take diligent care so to order and heed all things that nothing of the holy sacrament remain over, yet he shall especially at the end see to it that it be all distributed and used up, as Christ hath commanded, where he saith, Luke 22: Dividite inter nos …, that no grievous or offensive unseemliness befall.*

Note.

- **The communion chant.** The Latin *communio* (communion) of the day survives as the communion chant.
- **The priest's communion.** It is moved after the people's, so that nothing is left over. Sehling gives the background: this began in Nürnberg in 1524, and Luther wished it in order to cut short the question of what becomes of Christ's body and blood in the remaining elements.
- **The quotation.** "Dividite inter nos" (divide it among us) is as printed; the Vulgate reads *inter vos* (among you).

7.14.8 Thanksgiving, Latin ablution prayers, *Benedicamus*, blessing

Thereafter he shall sing these two collects under one conclusion in the accustomed tone, or say them with an audible voice. Let us pray: O almighty, everlasting God, we give praise and thanks unto thy divine bounty that thou hast fed us and given us to drink with the wholesome flesh and blood of thine only Son Jesus Christ our Lord; and we humbly beseech thee that thou wouldest work in us by thy Holy Spirit, that as we have received this holy sacrament with the mouth, so we may also with firm faith apprehend and for ever retain thy divine grace, forgiveness of sins, union with Christ and everlasting life, which are therein set forth and promised. *Another prayer.* We thank thee also, Lord Jesus Christ, that thou hast refreshed us through this wholesome gift of thy body and blood; and we beseech thy mercy that thou wouldest let the same prosper in us unto a strong faith toward thee and unto fervent love among us all; who with God the Father in the unity of the Holy Ghost livest and reignest ever and eternally. *Choir:* Amen. *Then let him bow and say:* May thy body, O Lord, which we sinners have received, and the cup which we have drunk, cleave unto our inward parts; and grant that no stain of sin may remain there where so pure and holy sacraments have entered. What we have received with the mouth, O Lord, may we take with a pure mind; and of a temporal gift may it become unto us an everlasting remedy; through Christ our Lord. Amen. *Thereafter he or his deacons, both or one, shall sing the Benedicamus Domino in the tone in which the Kyrie eleison was sung; and the choir shall answer in the very same tone:* Let us say thanks unto God. *Thereafter let the priest bless the people with a loud, audible voice thus:* The Lord bless you and keep you! The Lord lighten his countenance upon you and be gracious unto you! The Lord lift up his countenance upon you and give you peace! Amen. *Or thus:* God be merciful and gracious unto us and give us his divine blessing! May he cause his countenance to shine upon us and give us his peace! Amen. *Or thus:* Bless and keep us God the Father and the Son and the Holy Ghost. Amen. *Or thus:* The blessing of God the Father and of the Son and of the Holy Ghost be with you and remain alway with us all! Amen. *End of the Mass with communicants.*

Note.

- **The thanksgiving.** Brandenburg's single German thanksgiving is split into two collects "under one conclusion". The second is addressed to Christ.

- ***Corpus tuum.*** It keeps Brandenburg's older wording but reads "so pure and holy" and drops "almighty God".
- ***Quod ore sumpsimus.*** It has the full Roman text, with *et de munere temporali* (and from a temporal gift).
- ***Benedicamus.*** *Benedicamus Domino* (Let us bless the Lord) is answered "Deo dicamus gratias" (Let us say thanks to God), the form used at Lauds and Vespers.
- **The blessings.** They are Numbers 6:24–26, Psalm 67:1 and two Trinitarian forms.

7.15 Bugenhagen: the preparatory prayer, and "Hic est noster canon"

Johannes Bugenhagen's Masses keep nothing of the Canon. His Braunschweig order of 1528 (Sehling 6, I, pp. 440–442; doc 1983) runs as follows after the sermon:

- the chalice is prepared during a German hymn;
- an exhortation;
- on feasts, a Latin Preface and Sanctus;
- the Our Father, sung;
- the Verba over the bread, then communion of the bread;
- the Verba over the cup, then communion of the cup;
- the German *Agnus Dei* (Lamb of God);
- Luther's thanksgiving collect and the Aaronic blessing.

Bugenhagen's own comment on the Preface: "for the exhortation on the sacrament is the true Preface, that is, a foreword". The same order says of the Canon that it is "patched together out of many pieces like a beggar's cloak" (p. 440).

What his later orders do keep is a **preparatory prayer of the priest at the altar step** (*Stufengebet*). It is the evangelical counterpart of the Roman *Iudica me* (Judge me), *Confiteor* (I confess) and *Aufer a nobis* (Take away from us), and it is what is usually meant by "Bugenhagen's preparatory prayer". It appears in three forms.

Bugenhagen's northern Mass as a family of ordo is treated in Chapter 2, §2.4.2.

7.15.1 Braunschweig-Wolfenbüttel, *Christlike kerken-ordeninge*, 1543

Sehling 6, I/2, pp. 54–55 (`eko.db` doc 1972). The order came out of the visitation of 1542 by Bugenhagen, Antonius Corvinus and Martin Görlitz (Sehling 6, I, p. 12). It prints the German Benedictus and a psalm at the beginning of the Mass. The prayer is said while they are sung.

During the psalm or hymn the priest goeth before the altar, kneeleth down with the sexton, and prayeth for himself and for the people and for all the need of Christendom thus: Our Father, etc. *The sexton saith:* Amen. O Lord, deal not with us after our sins, etc. *The sexton:* Neither reward us according to our iniquities, etc. O Lord, remember not, etc. *The sexton:* Let thy mercies speedily prevent us, etc. Help us, O God, etc. *The sexton:* And be merciful, etc. *Thereafter the priest standeth up, and goeth before the altar, and prepareth himself to sing and to read.*

Note.

- **The versicles in full.** The versicles and responses are the Lenten tract *Domine, non secundum* (O Lord, deal not with us), from Ps 103:10 and Ps 79:8–9, which also stands in the *preces* of the Office:
  - "O Lord, deal not with us after our sins, neither reward us according to our iniquities."
  - "O Lord, remember not our former iniquities: let thy mercies speedily prevent us, for we are brought very low."
  - "Help us, O God of our salvation, and for the glory of thy name, O Lord, deliver us, and be merciful to our sins, for thy name's sake."
- **What it replaces.** The Roman prayers at the foot of the altar were said by the priest and server in dialogue: Ps 43 *Iudica me* (Judge me), the *Confiteor* (I confess) and *Misereatur* (May [almighty God] have mercy), the versicles *Adiutorium nostrum* (Our help) and *Deus, tu conversus* (O God, thou wilt turn again), and *Aufer a nobis* (Take away from us). Bugenhagen keeps the form: kneeling, in dialogue with the sexton as server, during the opening chant. He replaces the confession of sin with the Lord's Prayer and the tract's plea for mercy, "for himself and for the people and for all the need of Christendom". Sehling's editor calls it a "Stufengebet" (prayers at the foot of the altar).

The rest of the Wolfenbüttel Sacrament, for comparison with the orders above:

After all this the customary sermon taketh place. When it is out, and there are found such as will be communicated, the priest shall prepare bread and wine according to the number of his communicants; and they shall betake themselves to the altar and orderly dispose themselves to the communion, the men on the right, the women and maidens on the candle side. Then the priest turneth to the people that will be communicated, and readeth them an exhortation to the sacrament thus: My dearly beloved, it is continually set before us by the preaching of the Gospel of Christ that we of ourselves are ignorant, poor and lost sinners. […] He saith: This is my body, which is given for you. This is my blood, which is shed for you for the forgiveness of sins. That shall ye believe. But he commandeth: Take and eat. Drink ye all thereout, and remember me. That shall ye do according to his gracious word and command. Amen.

Note.

- **"the priest shall prepare bread and wine"** is all that is left of the offertory, as in Braunschweig 1528 and Schleswig-Holstein 1542.
- **The exhortation** (Braunschweig 1528, pp. 443f.) is Bugenhagen's "true Preface". The order also allows Luther's paraphrase of the Our Father to be read before it.
- **What follows.** The sung Our Father, the Verba over the bread, communion, the Verba over the cup, communion, the German *Agnus Dei* (Lamb of God), Luther's thanksgiving collect ("We give thanks to thee, almighty Lord God …") and the Aaronic blessing.
- **On feasts.** In towns the priest may sing a Latin Preface (Christmas, Easter, Whitsun; the Trinity Preface on other feasts; "the daily [Preface] one may simply let lie as unneeded"). The whole congregation then sings a German Sanctus, "Holy is God the Father, holy is God the Son, holy is God the Holy Ghost …". After it the exhortation may be left out.

7.15.2 Hildesheim, *Kirchenordnung*, 1544

Sehling 7, V, pp. 852–855 (`eko.db` doc 2136). This is the order for the city of Hildesheim, drawn up by Bugenhagen, Winkel and Corvinus. It has the same prayer, and at the end a private thanksgiving of the priest:

First one may sing before the introit a German psalm or hymn made out of the holy Scripture. During the singing the priest goeth before the altar and kneeleth down with the sexton, prayeth for himself and for the people and for all the need of Christendom thus: Our Father, etc. *The sexton saith:* Amen. O Lord, deal not with us after our sins, etc. *The sexton:* Neither reward us according to our iniquities, etc. O Lord, remember not, etc. *The sexton:* Let thy mercies speedily prevent us, etc. Help us, O God, etc. *The sexton:* And be merciful, etc. *Thereafter the priest standeth up and goeth before the altar, and prepareth himself to sing and to read.* […] *Then the schoolmaster beginneth a short German psalm, or what pleaseth him, and therewith an end, etc. But while the singing lasteth, the preacher unvesteth and layeth the Mass vestment together, kneeleth down again before the altar, and thanketh God secretly for himself.*

Note.

- **The sexton** is the "opperman" (sexton; *Opfermann*, the offertory-man).
- **The closing thanksgiving** is the evangelical form of the priest's private thanksgiving after Mass (*Gratiarum actio post missam*: *Trium puerorum*, Ps 150 and collects), still said kneeling and "secretly".

7.15.3 Schleswig-Holstein, *Christlyke Kercken Ordeninge*, 1542

Sehling 23, A, Nr. 7, p. 89 (`eko.db` doc 1576). This is the Low German form of the Danish *Ordinatio ecclesiastica* (1537), which Bugenhagen drew up. The text is fixed only by rubric:

A priest that will hold Mass, let him fall on his knees before the altar and read by himself the Confiteor. Let him pray for the preachers of the Gospel, for the King and for the realm, and also for these duchies. Thereafter let him conduct the Mass according to the old custom; yet so that he defile it not with the title of sacrifice or work, as the hypocrisy and mockery of the papists hath been heretofore. […] *But while the singing lasteth, the priest unvesteth and layeth the Mass vestment together, kneeleth down again before the altar, and thanketh God secretly for himself.*

Note.

- **The *Confiteor*** is kept in its Roman place and posture, said privately ("for himself").

- **The intercession** (preachers, king, realm, duchies) gathers into the preparation what the Canon's *Te igitur* (Thee therefore) and *Memento* had prayed for.
- **"according to the old custom".** The Mass is to be kept "according to the old custom", but without "the title of sacrifice or work".
- **At the Verba.** The Latin *Ordinatio* (Ordinance) allows an elevation at this point, "if it seem good to the minister", with the bells.

7.15.4 "Hic est noster canon"

Bugenhagen names the evangelical replacement of the Canon in two places. The first is the *Pia ordinatio caeremoniarum* for cathedral chapters and monasteries. Sehling prints it among the Pomeranian orders (4, pp. 345–352, doc 1857). Its Danish hymn incipits show it belongs with the Danish *Ordinatio* (Ordinance). The second is its Low German form in Schleswig-Holstein 1542 (p. 147).

After the word of God let them be admonished to pray for all conditions of all men, for the Church, for peace, salvation, etc. This is our Canon. But the papists have patched these serious things together with their lies into that secret Canon of the Mass.

After the sermon the people shall be admonished to pray for all manner of estates of the world, for the pastors, for peace, for salvation, etc. And that same prayer is our Canon. But the papists have patched such an earnest thing together with their lies into the secret Canon of the Mass.

Note.

- **The Canon has become the general prayer.** For Bugenhagen, the Church's intercession after the sermon *is* the Canon: the prayer "for the church … for peace" that *Te igitur* (Thee therefore) had once been. The German Masses of Strasbourg (§7.5.1–7.5.2) and Döber (§7.8.11) put the same intercession into the Canon's own place after the Sanctus. Bugenhagen moves it to after the sermon, where the general prayers of the later church orders stand.
- **"in ullum"** is Sehling's print, for *in illum*.

Appendix 7.A The Canon critique of 1533/1540/1543

This is Pfalz-Neuburg 1543, Sehling 13, I.2, p. 65. Sehling traces it through Brandenburg 1540 (Sehling 3, 64f.) to Brandenburg-Nürnberg 1533 (Sehling 11, 183f.). These are the register references 11:183 and 13:65. Sehling's footnotes to the three quotations give the Canon's own words; they are supplied here in brackets.

And if the adversaries would say (as they are then driven by the scripture alleged, if they be not altogether hardened) that they offer not, but mean only to make a memorial and representation of the first sacrifice, then shall one answer them thus: if they take out the words wherewith they plainly offer (but chiefly these: "which we offer unto thee for thy holy Christian Church, etc.", and: "We beseech thee that thou wouldest graciously accept this sacrifice and deliver us from eternal damnation, etc.", and: "We offer unto thy glorious majesty, etc."), and set in place thereof, "We remember the sacrifice of thine only Son, etc.", then will we believe that they are in earnest; and they are also bound to do it, and can well perform it without offence. For if they have set Kilian and Totnan therein for money's sake, which is of no profit, they should now rightly, for faith's and truth's sake, change these words where it is needful.

Note. The three passages condemned are the offering clauses of *Te igitur* (Thee therefore), *Hanc igitur* (This [oblation] therefore) and *Unde et memores* (Wherefore, mindful). Sehling's note explains "Kilian and Totnan". The Würzburg missal (Speciale missarum, Würzburg 1495) added these Würzburg martyrs, with Colonat, and confessors to the saints of the **embolism** *Libera nos* (Deliver us): "and also with thy holy martyrs Kilian, Colonat, Totnan and thy holy confessors Martin, Nicholas, Burchard, Benedict". The argument is that a Canon already changed for local saints can be changed for the truth.

The orders in this file answer the demand in two ways:

- **Worms 1524** (Moderate Reformed) had already done what the critique asks. It kept the Canon but turned each offering into prayer: "offer our humble prayer" (§7.6.8); "that thou wouldest accept us and all our prayer …" (§7.6.5).
- **Osiander's prayer in Pfalz-Neuburg 1543** (§7.14.2) does it half-way. It "brings" the gifts before the divine majesty, but offers bread and wine, not the body and blood.

Chapter 8. Hymn Practice

This chapter covers where hymns were sung in the evangelical church orders of the sixteenth century, as printed in Emil Sehling's *Die evangelischen Kirchenordnungen des XVI. Jahrhunderts* (The Evangelical Church Orders of the Sixteenth Century). It asks four questions:

- In which parts of the Mass, the offices and the occasional rites (baptism, weddings, the sick, burial, ordination) did the orders put hymns?
- Which hymns did they assign to each of these places?
- Was a given place filled by one fixed hymn, by a choice among a handful, or by a hymn that changed with the season, the feast, the Sunday gospel or the sermon?
- What reasons did the orders give for their choices?

It deals with the slots of the service, not with the propers as such. Where a hymn took the place of a proper (introit, gradual, alleluia, sequence, offertory, communion), the replacement is recorded. Troped, farced and paraphrased ordinaries (Kyrie, Gloria, Credo, Sanctus, Agnus Dei) are treated in full.

This chapter is separate from the hymn database, `hymns.db` (Introduction), which holds the per-Sunday and per-feast hymn tables. The tables it holds (Pomerania 1569, Pfalz-Zweibrücken 1565, Hof 1592, Weissenfels 1578, Mansfeld 1580, Hohenlohe 1596, Nördlingen 1579 and Heilbronn 1543) are referred to here but not repeated.

The findings are summarised in §8.1, and the method is described in §8.2. §8.3 sets out the slots in outline. §§8.4–8.15 follow the slots of the Mass in order. §8.16 covers the offices (with the *Benedicamus* and the old festal songs such as *Puer natus in Bethlehem* [A child is born in Bethlehem]), the catechism and the weekday services, and §8.17 the occasional rites. §8.18 gathers the reasons the orders give. §8.19 is a concordance of every order quoted. Appendix 8.A condenses the "Compare by day" sheet of `hymns.xlsx` into one table: the chief hymn (*Hauptlied*) of each Sunday and feast in the old sources, with its original, literal English and common English titles and its witnesses.

Related chapters. Several subjects are treated more fully elsewhere and are only cited here:

- the order of the Mass in which the slots stand: Chapter 2, §§2.4–2.5;
- the Latin propers that the hymns replaced: Chapter 4, §§4.3–4.9;
- the organ in alternation with choir and people: Chapter 9, §9.3;
- the offices and the catechism service in which the office hymns were sung: Chapter 10, §§10.7, 10.10;
- the Litany: Chapter 13, §13.21;
- the feasts and seasons: Chapter 12, §§12.10, 12.12;
- the prayer before the sermon and the sermon itself: Chapter 11, §11.10;
- the rites at which hymns were sung (baptism, marriage, burial and ordination): Chapter 13, §§13.3, 13.7, 13.9, 13.10.

8.1 Summary of findings

8.1.1 The main findings

1. Most hymn slots were fixed. In nearly every order a given place in the service was filled by one hymn, or by a choice among two to five. The choice was often exchanged at the high feasts for a hymn of the feast. Only one slot regularly changed from Sunday to Sunday: the hymn between the epistle and the gospel. From about 1560 a second slot joined it in some regions: the hymn after the sermon. The table in §8.1.2 sets out the pattern slot by slot.

2. The opening of the service was a prayer for the Holy Ghost. *Veni sancte Spiritus* (Come, Holy Spirit), in Latin or in German ("Komm heiliger Geist, Herre Gott", or the prose "Komm, heiliger Geist, erfülle"), or "Nun bitten wir" (Now pray we), was often sung kneeling. The Hessian *Agende* (1574, Philippist) gives the reason: "that the help and assistance of the Holy Ghost may be prayed for, for the performing of the whole service" (§8.4.1). Many orders also say plainly that the opening songs were sung "until the congregation cometh together" (§8.4.2). Some northern orders opened with the German Benedictus or the German Te Deum instead (§§8.4.3–8.4.4).

3. Hymns took the place of the introit, the gradual, the sequence and the offertory.

- **Introit.** A Scriptural Latin introit could be kept where a school sang it. Otherwise, and in the villages always, "a German psalm" was sung "in place of the introit". The usual psalms were Ps 67, 51, 130, 12, 124 and 14, or "Komm heiliger Geist" (Come, Holy Ghost), usually rotated (§8.5).
- **Gradual, alleluia and sequence.** These gave way to a German psalm or hymn, often chosen by season or gospel (§8.8).
- **Offertory.** This became a German psalm sung while bread and wine were prepared and the communicants came forward (§8.11.3). In Bugenhagen's orders the creed hymn "Wir glauben all" (We all believe) served here, sung after the sermon (§8.9.2).
- **Communion chant.** This was replaced by the communion hymns (§8.14).
- **Particular days.** A hymn replaced the gradual at the Purification ("Mit Fried und Freud"), the sequence in Passiontide (Ps 51), and the offertory at Christmas ("Ein Kindelein so löbelich") (§§8.8.5, 8.11.3).

4. The ordinaries were troped and paraphrased in German.

- **Kyrie.** Troped German Kyries survive in the Low German Mass of Schleswig-Holstein (after 1526), Naumburg (1537/38), Mecklenburg (1545), Ritzebüttel (1556), Pfalz-Zweibrücken (1557) and Hof (1592). They were sung to the melodies of the Latin troped Kyries, the *Fons bonitatis* (Fount of goodness) (also called the *summum* [the highest chant]), the *paschale* (Easter [Kyrie]) and the *Magne Deus* (Great God), and graded by season. The Latin tropes themselves are named at Nördlingen (1579) and printed in Hof's Holy Week office (1592) (§8.6.4). The Kyrie was also sung in three tongues, Greek, Latin and German (Prussia 1525, Riga 1530, Neuenrade 1564) (§8.6).
- **Gloria.** Decius's "Allein Gott in der Höh sei Ehr" (To God alone on high be glory), in Low German "Allene Godt yn der höge sy eer" (To God alone on high be glory), was the German Gloria of the corpus. Fifty-two orders name it in the Gloria slot (§8.7.6). It was sung for, alternately with, or inside the Latin Gloria. In the last case the whole German hymn was inserted between *Et in terra pax* (And on earth peace) and *Laudamus te* (We praise thee) (Schleswig-Holstein 1542, Wolfenbüttel 1543, Hildesheim 1544). Osnabrück (1543) sang it after the intonation and then the Latin to the end. The Lippe Mass [c. 1525–1538] and Neuenrade (1564) print all four stanzas in Low German. "All Ehr und Lob" (All honour and praise shall be God's) was the alternative (§8.7).
- **Creed.** "Wir glauben all" (§8.9).
- **Sanctus.** Luther's "Jesaia dem Propheten" (To Isaiah the prophet) was usual (§8.12). The Trinitarian troped Sanctus, "Heilig ist Gott der Vater" (Holy is God the Father), in Low German "Hillich is Got, de Vader" (Holy is God the Father), is named in five orders: Wolfenbüttel 1543, Mecklenburg 1545, Stralsund 1555, Harlingerland 1573/74 and Hof 1592. One of Sehling's editors gives it to Decius; another calls it anonymous. No order assigns it to Advent, or to any season. The rules are of rank and place: German "at the other times" than the feasts, in the villages, during the communion, or in four parts at Hof on two feasts (§8.12.2).
- **Agnus Dei.** "Christe, du Lamm Gottes" (Christ, thou Lamb of God) and "O Lamm Gottes unschuldig" (O Lamb of God, innocent; §8.15). Decius's "O Lamm Gottes unschuldig" is found only in its short form, which follows the threefold Agnus Dei. It is one stanza sung three times, and the third time it ends with the prayer for peace instead of the prayer for mercy, as the Latin ends with *dona nobis pacem* (grant us peace) (Calenberg-Göttingen 1542, Mecklenburg 1545, Neuenrade 1564, Engerhafe 1583, Hof 1592). No order uses the longer five-stanza version. Its four new stanzas, two on the Passion and two of thanks and prayer, begin "O Lamm Gottes im Staube" (O Lamb of God in the dust), "O Lamm Gottes, unschuldig, / Trugst du die herbe Verhöhnung" (O Lamb of God, innocent, thou didst bear the bitter mockery), "Von Herzen wir dir danken" (From our hearts we thank thee) and "Stärk in uns das Vertrauen" (Strengthen in us the trust). None of their lines occurs in the corpus (§8.15).
- **Lord's Prayer and Verba.** No troped or farced Lord's Prayer or Words of Institution was found. The congregation sometimes sang Luther's "Vater unser im Himmelreich" (Our Father in the kingdom of heaven; §8.13).

5. At the three high feasts the Latin sequences were farced with German stanzas. The pairs were *Grates nunc omnes* (Let us all now give thanks) with "Gelobet seist du", *Victimae paschali* with "Christ lag in Todesbanden" (or "Christ ist erstanden" [Christ is arisen]), and *Veni sancte Spiritus* with "Nun bitten wir". Choir and people, or organ and cantor, sang by turns (§8.8.3). Most other sequences were dropped as impure (§8.8.2).

6. Before the sermon the congregation prayed in song. The hymn was "Nun bitten wir", often begun by the preacher from the pulpit, and sung "in place of prayer". At the high feasts the old pre-Reformation *Leisen* took its place: "Ein Kindelein so löbelich", "Christ ist erstanden", "Christ fuhr gen Himmel" (Christ went up to heaven), "Gott der Vater wohn uns bei" (God the Father, dwell with us). Some orders sang the Lord's Prayer hymn in Lent or Advent. Several orders give the whole year as a seasonal table (§8.10).

7. After the sermon the core hymn was "Erhalt uns, Herr, bei deinem Wort". It was sung as a prayer for the word against the Pope and the Turk (Prussia 1568: "as after every sermon always"). Other choices were "Es woll uns Gott genädig sein" (May God be gracious to us) and "Gott der Vater wohn uns bei". From the 1570s the Hanau-Lichtenberg, Hohenlohe, Öhringen, Reutlingen, Rostock and Marienhafe orders wanted a hymn that "agreeth with the sermon". Hohenlohe (1596) gave a menu under twelve doctrinal articles (§8.11.5).

8. The communion hymns hardly changed through the century. The core was Hus's "Jesus Christus unser Heiland" (Jesus Christ our Saviour), "Gott sei gelobet" (God be praised), "Jesaia dem Propheten" and Ps 111, followed by the German Agnus Dei. What changed was the number of hymns, measured almost everywhere by the number of communicants. Bugenhagen's orders stopped the song as soon as the distribution ended, "though a song begun be not sung out" (§8.14.3). Festal hymns, the Passion, *Discubuit*, *Pange lingua* (Sing, my tongue) and the Te Deum were added at the margin (§8.14).

9. Hymns covered movements and actions. Many orders say that the hymn is sung "while" or "meanwhile":

- the people gather (§8.4.2);
- the priest prays at the altar step (§8.4.6);
- the preacher goes up into or comes down from the pulpit (§§8.9.3, 8.10.5, 8.11.2);
- the priest "takes a little breath" (§8.11.2) or puts on his vestments (§8.11.2);
- the bread and wine are prepared (§8.11.3);
- the communicants come into the choir (§§8.11.4, 8.12.1);
- the celebrant takes off his vestments (§8.15.4).

Hof sang at baptism "that two actions may not follow one upon the other without a song" (§8.17.1).

10. The rules for choosing a hymn grew stricter over the century. In broad order, the reasons given were these:

- The text must be from Scripture and "pure" (§8.18.1).
- The hymn must "rhyme with the feast" and the season (§8.18.2).
- On ordinary Sundays it should "rhyme with the gospel". The rule of Pomerania 1542 and Mecklenburg 1545 lists hymns for gospels of faith and grace, of Christ's enemies, of good works, and of the use of earthly goods (§8.8.6).
- It should agree with the sermon (§§8.11.5, 8.18.3).
- In the catechism service it should be the hymn of the chief part being taught (§8.16.6).

Alongside these ran the practical reasons:

- The people should learn a few hymns well, repeated and rotated (§8.18.4).
- Luther's hymns should come first. Prussia 1568 says no new poet "can hold a candle to Luther" (§8.18.5).
- Private choice by schoolmasters and organists was to be curbed.
- Authorized cantionals were enforced: Spangenberg, Lossius, and an "unfalsified" Luther songbook (§8.18.6).
- There were limits of language, length and organ use (§§8.18.7–8.18.9).

11. The *Benedicamus* was graded, put into German and sometimes replaced, but never troped. No order in the corpus prescribes a *Benedicamus* troped with a festal song such as *Puer natus in Bethlehem* (A child is born in Bethlehem). The *Benedicamus* kept seasonal melodies (*in adventu*, *angelicum*, *dominicale*, *paschale* with alleluia), and was sung in German ("Let us bless the Lord") at the end of the Mass or office. It could give way to a figured motet of the feast (Hof 1592) or to a German hymn, at Christmas "Dank sagen wir alle" (Let us all give thanks to God; Nördlingen 1555, Wolfenbüttel 1569). *Puer natus in Bethlehem* and the other festal songs were sung next to it: upon the Magnificat (Naumburg 1537), at the entrance or going out of vespers (Pomerania 1569, Hof 1592), for the introit, and after the catechism or sermon (§§8.16.8–8.16.10).

8.1.2 The slots compared

"Fixed" means one hymn, or one per grade or feast. "A handful" means a named choice of two to five, often rotated. "Variable" means the hymn changed with the Sunday, gospel or sermon.

Slot	Where it falls	Hymns usually named	How fixed
Opening (§8.4)	before the introit, or before the sermon in	*Veni sancte* / "Komm heiliger Geist" (Come, Holy Ghost); "Nun bitten" (Now pray we the Holy Ghost); German Benedictus;	**fixed** or a handful; graded

Slot	Where it falls	Hymns usually named	How fixed
	the Württemberg type	German Te Deum; Ps 51	by feast in some orders
For the introit (§8.5)	first chant of the Mass	"Es woll uns Gott" (May God be gracious to us; Ps 67), "Erbarm dich mein" (Have mercy on me, O Lord God; Ps 51), "Aus tiefer Not" (Out of deep distress; Ps 130), "Ach Gott vom Himmel" (O God, look down from heaven; Ps 12), "Wär Gott nicht mit uns" (Were God not with us at this time; Ps 124), "Komm heiliger Geist"; festal *Leisen*	**a handful**, rotated; festal exchange
Kyrie (§8.6)	after the introit or confession	Latin by grade; German plain or troped ("Kyrie, Gott Vater in Ewigkeit", "Ach Vater, allerhöchster Gott", "O Herre Gott", "O Vater allmächtiger Gott")	**fixed by grade and season**
Gloria (§8.7)	after the Kyrie	"Allein Gott in der Höh" (To God alone on high be glory); "All Ehr und Lob" (All honour and praise shall be God's)	**fixed**; Latin and German alternate or combine
Between epistle and gospel (§8.8)	the gradual, alleluia and sequence	farced sequences at the high feasts; German psalm matched to season or gospel; litany-hymn "Nim von uns" (Take from us)	**variable**: Sunday or seasonal tables, gospel rule
Creed (§8.9)	after the gospel, or after the sermon	"Wir glauben all" (We all believe); sung Apostles' or Nicene Creed	**fixed**; place varies
Before the sermon (§8.10)	after the creed or prayers; from the pulpit	"Nun bitten"; *Leisen* at feasts; Lord's Prayer hymn	**fixed with seasonal exchange**
After the sermon (§8.11)	after the sermon and prayers; the offertory place	"Erhalt uns" (Keep us); "Es woll uns Gott"; "Gott der Vater wohn uns bei" (God the Father, dwell with us); any German psalm; sermon-matched hymn	**a handful**, becoming **variable** in later orders
Sanctus (§8.12)	after the preface or exhortation	"Jesaia dem Propheten" (To Isaiah the prophet); "Heilig ist Gott der Vater" (Holy is God the Father); Latin Sanctus by grade	**fixed**
Lord's Prayer and Verba (§8.13)	before the distribution	"Vater unser im Himmelreich" (Our Father in the kingdom of heaven; rare)	**fixed** or none
Under the communion (§8.14)	during the distribution	"Jesus Christus unser Heiland" (Jesus Christ our Saviour); "Gott sei gelobet" (God be praised); "Jesaia"; Ps 111; Agnus; extras by number of communicants	**fixed core**; quantity varies
Post-communion (§8.15)	after the distribution	"Christe, du Lamm Gottes" (Christ, thou Lamb of God); "O Lamm Gottes" (O Lamb of God); "Gott sei gelobet"	**fixed**
Close (§8.15)	after the blessing	"Verleih uns Frieden" (Grant us peace) / *Da pacem* (Give peace); "Erhalt uns"; "Es woll uns Gott"; "Sei Lob und Ehr" (Praise and honour be to the highest good); "Dank sagen wir alle" (Let us all give thanks to God); festal hymn	**a handful**; festal exchange
Benedicamus (§§8.16.8–	end of vespers, matins, and some	Latin by grade; German "Last uns gesegnen den herren" (Let us bless the Lord); "Dank sagen wir alle" at Christmas; figured	**fixed by grade**; replaced at

Slot	Where it falls	Hymns usually named	How fixed
8.16.10)	Masses	motet; festal songs (*Puer natus in Bethlehem*) next to it, not in it	feasts
Office hymn (§8.16)	vespers, matins	Latin hymn *de tempore* (of the season), purged; German office hymns	**fixed by season**
Catechism service (§8.16.6)	before or after the catechism sermon	the hymn of the chief part	**fixed by the part taught**
Occasional rites (§8.17)	baptism, wedding, burial, ordination	"Christ unser Herr zum Jordan kam" (Christ our Lord came to the Jordan); Ps 127/128; "Mitten wir im Leben" (In the midst of life we are), "Mit Fried und Freud" (With peace and joy I depart), "Nun lasst uns den Leib begraben" (Now let us bury the body); "Nun bitten", Te Deum	**a handful** per rite

8.1.3 How the practice changed over the century

- **1523–1535: Luther and Bugenhagen.** Luther's *Formula missae* (1523) wanted German songs near the gradual, Sanctus and Agnus. The *Deutsche Messe* (1526) filled these slots. Bugenhagen's orders (Braunschweig 1528, Hamburg 1529, Pomerania 1535) fixed the northern pattern:
  - German psalm or Benedictus at the start;
  - farced sequences at three feasts;
  - creed as offertory;
  - Hus's hymn and "Gott sei gelobet" (God be praised) at communion, stopped when the distribution ends;
  - "Christe du Lamm Gottes" (Christ, thou Lamb of God) after all have communicated.
- **1540s: the gospel rule and the *Leisen*.** Pomerania (1542) and Mecklenburg (1545) chose the post-epistle hymn by the matter of the gospel. The *Leisen* before the sermon became standard. Mecklenburg 1552 had the preachers sing them from the pulpit, and Lüneburg (1564), Wolfenbüttel (1569) and Oldenburg (1573) copied the rule.
- **1550s–1590s: tables, sermons, catechism and books.**
  - Sunday tables appeared (Pirna 1555, Pfalz-Zweibrücken 1565, Pomerania 1569, Weissenfels 1578, Mansfeld 1580, Hof 1592, Hohenlohe 1596).
  - Orders asked for hymns matched to the sermon (Hanau-Lichtenberg 1573, Öhringen 1582, Brieg 1592, Marienhafe 1593, Hohenlohe 1596).
  - Catechism hymns spread (Lippe 1571, Hoya 1581, Grubenhagen 1581).
  - Luther's hymns were defended as a canon (Prussia 1568, Harlingerland 1573/74, Hoya 1581).
  - Cantionals were imposed (Lossius, Spangenberg).
- **1607: Hessen-Kassel.** As Hesse turned Reformed, Lobwasser's psalms entered the communion. Hymn numbers were posted on boards at the church doors, and the synod asked for a table of hymns "accommodated to the texts which should be preached" (§8.18.3).

8.2 Scope, sources and method

8.2.1 The corpus

The source is `eko.db`, the full-text database of Sehling's edition (Introduction). It holds 2,368 records in 32 digitized volumes and half-volumes, with Sehling's own subject registers. The orders run from Luther's *Formula missae* (1523) to the early seventeenth century. They cover Saxony, Thuringia, the Harz counties, Brandenburg, Silesia, Prussia, Pomerania, Mecklenburg, the Baltic, Schleswig-Holstein, Lower Saxony, Westphalia, Hesse, the Rhineland, Franconia, Bavaria, Württemberg, Swabia, Alsace and Transylvania.

The chapter quotes 164 orders, held in 145 records. Some records hold several orders: for example, the Henneberg village reports, the Nördlingen and Schwäbisch Hall volumes, and Prussia 1544/1568.

8.2.2 How the corpus was searched

The search was done in three passes.

1. **Slot vocabulary.** The whole text was searched for the terms by which the orders name the places of hymns:
   - Latin: *introitus*, *pro introitu*, *loco introitus* (in place of the introit), *post confessionem* (after the confession), *post epistolam* (after the epistle), *graduale* (gradual), *sequentia* (sequence), *prosa* (prose), *tractus* (tract), *post evangelium* (after the gospel), *ante concionem* (before the sermon), *post concionem* (after the sermon), *offertorium* (offertory), *sub communione*, *post communionem* (after the communion), *conclusio* (conclusion), *pro ingressu* (for the entrance), *Benedicamus*, *hymnus* (hymn), *cantilena* (song), *cantio* (song).
   - German and Low German: *an stat des introitus*, *für den introitum* (for the introit), *für das Halleluja* (for the Alleluia), "in place of the offertory", *an stat des sequenz* (in place of the sequence), *vor der predigt* (before the sermon), *nach der predigt* (after the sermon), *auf die epistel*, *nach der epistel* (after the epistle), *unter der communion* (during the communion), *under der berichtinge* (during the communion), *zum beschluss* (at the conclusion), *tom beslute* (at the conclusion), *deutscher Psalm*, *düdesch psalm* (German psalm), *Lied* (song), *Leise* (Leise (a vernacular hymn ending Kyrieleis)), *Gesang* (song), *Lobgesang* (song of praise), *figurieren* (sing in figured music), *orgel* (organ).
   - The incipits of the common hymns and of the ordinaries in German ("Kyrie, Gott Vater", "Allein Gott", "All Ehr und Lob", "Wir glauben", "Jesaia dem Propheten", "Heilig ist Gott", "Christe du Lamm", "O Lamm Gottes").
2. **Registers.** Sehling's per-volume registers of *Lieder und Gesänge* (Hymns and songs) were read, and every page they cite was checked.
3. **Reading the orders.** About three hundred orders with hymn material were then read in the passages around each hit. Notes were taken slot by slot, and the rites were read in full.

The chapter gives the passages that state a rule, give a reason, or show a practice clearly. Where many orders say the same thing, the earliest or clearest is quoted and the others are named.

8.2.3 Cautions

- **Prescription, not observation.** Church orders say what should be sung. Only a few sources report what was actually sung. The Henneberg village pastors' reports of 1562–1566 are the richest of these (Sehling 2, pp. 329–357), with the Langenburg dispute of 1592. Even these may describe what the pastor wished the visitors to read.
- **"Psalm".** In these orders *ein deutscher Psalm* (a German psalm) means any German metrical hymn, not only a psalm paraphrase. "Aus tiefer Not" (Out of deep distress) is a psalm; so is "Nun freut euch" (Now rejoice).
- **Database headings.** The database's record headings, years and numbering do not always match the orders inside them. This chapter names each order from Sehling's running heads. In particular:
  - Doc 373 (headed 1544) is the Nördlingen St George's order of 1555.
  - Doc 1955 (headed 1590) is the Hadeln order of 1526.
  - Doc 2065 (headed 1571) is the Hoya order of 1581.
  - Doc 1809 holds both the Liegnitz order of 1542 and the Brieg order of 1592.
  - Doc 1248 holds the Henneberg village orders of Belrieth, Goldlauter, Herpf and Meiningen. The running head spells Goldlauter "Groldlauter".
  - Doc 1249 holds Obermassfeld and Queienfeld. A passage on p. 344–345 belongs to Queienfeld, though the running head of p. 345 names Ritschenhausen.
  - Doc 1250 holds Suhl, Sulzfeld and Wasungen (p. 356 is Wasungen, not Vachdorf).
  - Doc 84 is the Eisfeld visitation order of 1554, and doc 78 the Dresden Kreuzkirche order of 1574.
  - Doc 1262 holds the Anhalt order of 3 August 1548 and the *Ordnung der deutschen Gesänge* (Order of the German songs) of before 8 February 1551.
  - Doc 2204 holds two Goslar chapter orders, of 1560 (p. 319–321) and August 1566 (p. 322–323).
  - Doc 2003, 2009 and 2017 (Lüneburg) are in half-volume 6/1.
- **Sehling's summaries.** For Danzig (1557) Sehling prints a summary with quotations, and the chapter quotes it as such.
- **Apparatus.** Footnotes, variant readings and editorial notes are interleaved in the database text. They have been removed from quotations. Where a quotation crosses a page break or a footnote, the break is marked "[…]".
- **Later additions.** A few passages are later additions printed with an earlier order. The Brandenburg-Nürnberg rule on the burial of the unrepentant (§8.17.4) is one; the 1577 variants of Kurpfalz 1556 (§8.12.1) are another. They are marked as such.
- **Not repeated here.** The per-Sunday hymn tables already extracted into `hymns.db` are described in the Introduction (The hymn database) and are not repeated.

8.3 The hymn slots in outline

8.3.1 What the orders called the slots

Most orders name a slot by where it falls: before or after something, or in the place of something. The Latin orders use *introitus* (introit), *post confessionem* (after the confession), *post epistolam* (after the epistle), *post evangelium* (after the gospel), *ante concionem* (before the sermon), *post concionem* (after the sermon), *sub communione* (during the communion) and *conclusio* (conclusion). The German and Low German orders say *vor der predigt* (before the sermon), *nach der predigt* (after the sermon), *unter der communion* (during the communion) and *zum beschluss* (at the conclusion). The replacement of a chant is always marked: *an stat des introitus* (in place of the introit), *für das Halleluja* (for the Alleluia), "in place of the offertory", *an stat des sequenz* (in place of the sequence), *pro introitu* (for the introit), *loco Et in terra* (in place of the Et in terra).

The fullest set of slot labels is the three-week hymn plan of **Pfalz-Zweibrücken, *Ordnung der Kirchengesänge*, 17 August 1565** (Sehling 18, p. 337). Its first Sunday after Trinity reads:

Introitus (Introit): "Now rejoice, dear Christians all," the first melody; "Come, Holy Ghost." *After the confession*: the second Kyrie. *After the epistle*: "I believe in God," etc. *Before the sermon*: "Now pray we," etc. *After the sermon*: "Lord, how long wilt thou forget," etc. *Conclusion*: "Christ, our Saviour."

The Mass order of **Hof, *Ordo ecclesiasticus*, 1592** (Sehling 11, p. 425) numbers the same slots. The eighth is the German hymn to the Holy Ghost before the sermon, sung kneeling:

Eighthly, the organist beginneth the German song directed to the Holy Ghost, "Now pray we the Holy Ghost," etc. (or else some motet in figured song). That German song is continued by the three choirs upon bended knees.

8.3.2 Luther's two orders

Luther's *Formula missae* (Form of the Mass) wished for German songs "near the gradual, the Sanctus and the Agnus Dei", and said that the poets to write them were lacking. **Wittenberg, Luther, *Formula missae*, 1523** (Sehling 1, pp. 8–9):

I would also that we had as many songs as may be in the vulgar tongue, which the people might sing during the Mass, either next to the graduals, and likewise next to the Sanctus and Agnus Dei. For who doubteth that these were once the voices of the whole people, which now the choir alone singeth, or answereth to the bishop when he blesseth? […] But poets are wanting to us, or are not yet known, which might make us godly and spiritual songs (as Paul calleth them), such as be worthy to be used often in the church of God.

Three years later the *Deutsche Messe* (German Mass) had its slots filled. It opens with a German psalm to the first tone, puts a German hymn after the epistle and the German creed after the gospel. **Wittenberg, Luther, *Deutsche Messe*, 1526** (Sehling 1, p. 14):

But at the beginning we sing a spiritual song or a German psalm in the first tone, after the manner following: "I will bless the Lord at all times."

After the epistle a German song is sung, "Now pray we the Holy Ghost," or some other, and that with the whole choir. Then he readeth the gospel in the fifth tone […] After the gospel the whole church singeth the creed in German: "We all believe in one God."

At the communion the *Deutsche Messe* allows the German Sanctus, "Gott sei gelobet" (God be praised) or Hus's hymn. These three were for the whole century the core of the communion slot (§8.14) (Sehling 1, p. 15):

And the while let the German Sanctus be sung, or the song "God be praised," or John Hus's song, "Jesus Christ our Saviour." Thereafter let the cup be blessed and given likewise, and let that be sung which remaineth of the aforenamed songs, or the German Agnus Dei.

8.3.3 A whole service in hymns

Where there was no school to sing Latin, nearly every part of the service became a German hymn. The village order of the city of Braunschweig lists them in order. **Braunschweig, *Ordnung der ceremonien auf den dorfern*, undated** (Sehling 6/1, p. 473):

First the pastor shall sing with the sexton and all the people "Come, Holy Ghost, Lord God," etc. 2. Thereafter the Kyrie and *Et in terra* (And on earth) in German, as Doctor Martin hath put them into German. 3. Thereupon the pastor shall read the collects and the epistle. 4. Then shall the sexton with the people sing the Our Father, also as Doctor Martin hath made it. 5. After this the pastor shall read to the people the five chief parts of the catechism [...]. 6. Thereupon the sexton shall sing with the people first the creed, thereafter "Now pray we the Holy Ghost." 7. Then shall the pastor read the gospel from the pulpit and preach the sermon thereon. 8. After the sermon the sexton shall sing with the people the Sanctus of Isaiah in German. 9. Thereafter the pastor shall read the exhortation to the communicants, and straightway thereafter sing the Our Father and the words of the Supper in German. 10. During the communion the sexton shall sing with the people "Jesus Christ" or "God be praised," one Sunday after the other, when the Lord's Supper is held.

The same order closes with "Es wolt uns Gott genedig sein" (May God be gracious to us) and "Erhalt uns, Herr" (Keep us, Lord, by thy word) on alternate Sundays (§8.15.3).

8.3.4 Three shapes of service

The slots fall differently in three kinds of service. The hymns in each kind are much alike.

	Mass-shaped (Saxony, Bugenhagen's northern orders, Brandenburg, Prussia, Pomerania, Mecklenburg, Hesse (Moderate Reformed))	**Preaching service with communion (Württemberg and its derivatives, Kurpfalz 1556, Pfalz-Zweibrücken, Baden, Strasbourg)**	**Village Mass without a school**
Opening	Latin introit, or German psalm in its place; often *Veni sancte* or "Komm heiliger Geist" (Come, Holy Ghost) first	"Komm heiliger Geist", "Nun bitten" (Now pray we the Holy Ghost) or a German psalm "suited to the season"	"Komm heiliger Geist" or a German psalm
Kyrie, Gloria	Latin, German, or troped German Kyrie; "Allein Gott" (To God alone) for or with *Et in terra* (And on earth)	none	German Kyrie; "Allein Gott"
After the epistle	sequence, alleluia or German psalm; farced sequence at the three high feasts	none	German psalm or hymn "de tempore" (of the season)
Creed	"Wir glauben all" (We all believe) after the gospel, or after the sermon	sometimes after the sermon	"Wir glauben all"
Before the sermon	"Nun bitten"; the old *Leisen* at the high feasts	the opening hymn serves	"Nun bitten"
After the sermon	a psalm-hymn, "Erhalt uns" (Keep us), or a hymn in the place of the offertory	a German psalm or the creed while the pastor goes to the altar	"Es woll uns Gott" (May God be gracious to us) or "Erhalt uns"
Communion	German Sanctus, "Jesus Christus unser Heiland" (Jesus Christ our Saviour), "Gott sei gelobet" (God be praised), Ps 111, O Lamm Gottes	"Gott sei gelobet", "Jesus Christus", German Sanctus	the same
Close	"Christe du Lamm Gottes" (Christ, thou Lamb of God), "Verleih uns Frieden" (Grant us peace), "Erhalt uns", festal hymn	"Erhalt uns", "Verleih uns Frieden"	"Erhalt uns"

The Württemberg shape begins with a hymn, then the sermon, then the communion. There is no introit, Kyrie, Gloria or sequence to replace. In its orders the whole weight of hymn choice falls on the hymns before and after the sermon and during the distribution. The *Kirchenordnung* (church order) of 1553 (Sehling 16, p. 252):

When, then, the Supper of Christ is purposed to be held in the church upon a Sunday or other holy day, the song "Come, Holy Ghost," etc., "Now pray we the Holy Ghost," etc., or else a German psalm or spiritual song, especially one agreeable to the season, shall be sung at the beginning. After this song the common sermon shall be held.

The Bugenhagen orders give the plainest reason for all these German songs. **Hamburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1529** (Sehling 5, p. 491), after listing the parts of the Mass:

All this is done for the most part in German for the people's sake, since Christ hath commanded: "This do in remembrance of me."

8.4 The opening of the service

Before the introit, or instead of it, stood a hymn or chant that asked for the Holy Ghost, or a German canticle. These opening pieces are the most fixed of all the slots. The choice is nearly always between the Latin antiphon *Veni sancte Spiritus* (Come, Holy Spirit), its German form "Komm heiliger Geist, Herre Gott" (Come, Holy Ghost, Lord God), and "Nun bitten wir den heiligen Geist" (Now pray we the Holy Ghost). A second group opens with a German canticle: the Benedictus, the Te Deum, or Psalm 51.

8.4.1 *Veni sancte Spiritus* and "Komm heiliger Geist"

The Hessian *Agende* (Philippist) gives the reason. The whole service is asked of the Holy Ghost at its beginning, on bended knees. **Hessen, *Agende*, 1574** (Philippist; Sehling 8, p. 411):

First the scholars sing upon bended knees "Come, Holy Ghost," etc., that the help and assistance of the Holy Ghost may be prayed for, for the performing of the whole service of the church. 2. Thereafter is sung the introit of the Trinity, or of the season at the Nativity, the Resurrection and Pentecost. 3. Hereupon followeth the Kyrie and *Et in terra* (And on earth).

The order of the village of Bruchhausen in the abbey lands of Corvey (1603) copies this sentence word for word (Sehling 21, p. 244).

At Hof the German forms were sung kneeling by the whole choir whenever the organ was silent. There were two of them: "Komm, du herzlich Tröster" (Come, thou heartfelt Comforter; the German *Veni sancte Spiritus* [Come, Holy Spirit] sequence) and Luther's "Komm, heiliger Geist, Herre Gott" (Come, Holy Ghost, Lord God). **Hof, *Ordo ecclesiasticus*, 1592** (Sehling 11, p. 424):

As oft as there is no use of the organ, the whole choir setteth before the introit *Veni, sancte*, etc., "Come, thou heartfelt Comforter," etc., in German, with bended knees. This being ended, the introit beginneth. Doctor Luther's song, "Come, Holy Ghost, Lord God," etc., may also be set before the introit.

Soest, whose order follows Bugenhagen's Braunschweig order, had three boys sing it kneeling at the altar. **Soest, *Kirchenordnung*, 1532** (Sehling 22, p. 450):

At certain times three little boys may be made to sing, kneeling before the altar, the *Veni sancte Spiritus* in German or Latin before the Mass, thereupon a German collect.

In the late Verden order the antiphon is the priest's preparation at the altar, with versicle and collect. **Verden, *Kirchenordnung*, 1606** (Sehling 7/1, p. 155):

First, when the priest or pastor is come before the altar, the choir shall begin the antiphon *Veni, sancte Spiritus*. Thereafter the priest shall sing: *Emitte Spiritum et creabuntur* (Send forth thy Spirit, and they shall be created). The choir shall answer: *Et renovabis faciem terrae* (And thou shalt renew the face of the earth).

Some orders grade the opening hymn by feast. At Nördlingen the three stanzas of "Komm heiliger Geist" (Come, Holy Ghost) belonged to the high feasts. On other feasts and on Sundays all the stanzas of "Nun bitten" (Now pray we the Holy Ghost) were sung, by two choirs, the school and the people, while the celebrant made his confession. **Nördlingen, *Kirchenordnung* of Kaspar Löner, 1544** (Sehling 12, p. 311):

Meanwhile two choirs, one of the school, the other of the people, shall sing by turns on high feasts "Come, Holy Ghost," all three stanzas through. But on other feasts and on Sundays, "Now pray we the Holy Ghost," with all its stanzas.

At Reutlingen the same pair of hymns ran from the last bell until the preacher was in the pulpit. **Reutlingen, *Ordnung der Schule und des Kirchengesangs*, 1565/1566** (Sehling 17/2, p. 49):

On the Sunday, at the chief sermon, the schoolmaster and the usher with the boys shall go into the church after the second bell hath been rung, and there, in the stead of the introit, sing one, two or more customary psalms, and at the last, either during or after the ringing together, the song "Come, Holy Ghost," or "Now pray we the Holy Ghost," etc., until the preacher goeth up into the pulpit.

The prose German form of the antiphon, "Komm, heiliger Geist, erfülle die Herzen" (Come, Holy Ghost, fill the hearts), was sung to the Latin melody. On the Henneberg prayer days it followed the litany and covered the preacher's going up into the pulpit. **Henneberg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1582** (Sehling 2, p. 311):

and when the same is ended, then thereupon the German "Come, Holy Ghost, fill the hearts," etc. shall be sung after the notes of the Latin *Veni sancte Spiritus*; during this song the preacher shall betake himself up into the pulpit.

8.4.2 Singing while the people gather

A reason given again and again for the opening songs is plain: the people were still coming in. The Dortmund order even defines the introit this way. **Dortmund, *Gottesdienstordnung*, 1554** (Sehling 21, p. 208):

The introit is, and shall be, a psalm or another spiritual song of praise, which is sung while the people go in and gather themselves into the church, from which also it hath its name.

Northeim, *Kirchenordnung*, 1539 (Sehling 6/2, p. 925), defending the Latin chants against those who would have no ceremonies:

Why should one not sing, and let remain, a pure introit, Kyrie eleison, *Gloria in excelsis* and the *Et in terra* (And on earth), until the congregation were come together? For my own person I can indeed find no reason for it.

Hessen, *Kirchenordnung*, 1566 (Moderate Reformed; Sehling 8, p. 248):

First, until the congregation cometh together, a psalm or two are sung, according to the occasion of every place.

Bremen, *Kirchenordnung*, 1561 (Sehling 7/2.2, p. 513), for the weekday sermons:

Let there also be set before every sermon some German songs, until the people flock together.

Lippe, *Kirchenordnung*, 1571 (Sehling 21, p. 396). In the villages, where the people lived far apart, the Kyrie itself served while they gathered. On the high feasts a hymn of the feast took the place of the introit:

Forasmuch as the folk dwell here and there scattered far from one another, [he shall] begin with the German or Latin Kyrie until the congregation come together. But upon the high feast days a spiritual song according to the occasion of the feast shall be sung for the introit. Thereafter shall follow "To God alone on high be glory."

A Henneberg pastor wrote in his report that without communicants a psalm took the place of the Kyrie and *Et in terra*, "that the people might meanwhile come together". **Belrieth and Einhausen (Henneberg), *Gottesdienst-Ordnung*, 1566** (Sehling 2, p. 330):

But when no communicants are present, I cause first, in the stead of the Kyrie and *Et in terra*, a psalm to be sung, that the people may meanwhile gather themselves together.

Bremen had the sexton see that German hymns were sung while the last bell rang. **Bremen, *Kirchenordnung*, 1534** (Sehling 7/2.2, p. 464):

Then shall the sexton see to it that a song be sung in the church, as "Now is salvation come to us," "Now rejoice, dear Christians all," and *Veni Sancte Spiritus* (Come, Holy Spirit) in German or Latin, when the last sign is to be rung.

Goslar, *Neugestaltung des Gottesdienstes* in the chapter church of SS. Simon and Jude, 1560 (Sehling 7/2.2, p. 320), at the Sunday vespers:

or the people that gather for the sermon shall sing Christian songs of praise until the clock strike two.

The cost of this practice was noticed. The Mansfeld *Agenda* complained that Luther's hymns were being forgotten because they were sung only at the start, before the people were there, while the towns sang Latin and figured music. **Mansfeld, *Kirchen-Agenda*, 1580**, article XVIII (Sehling 2, p. 234):

We find that, alas, the fair psalms of Doctor Luther, the dear man of God and last prophet of the German land, and the spiritual German songs of other excellent men, are in many places so fallen into disuse and forgetting that the young folk growing up after know little of them. And this cometh thereof, that they are sung in the church very little and seldom, or perchance at the beginning of the office, before the people come together; or also that in the towns the Latin songs and figured music are for the most part kept.

8.4.3 The German Benedictus

Bugenhagen's orders often begin the Mass with the German Benedictus ("Gelobet sei der Herr, der Gott Israel"), sung by the schoolmaster, the children and all the people. It is sung without the organ, so that the people might learn the words of Scripture. **Wolfenbüttel, *Kirchenordnung*, 1543** (Sehling 6/1, p. 54):

First the schoolmaster beginneth, and singeth the German Benedictus with his children and with all the people. […] Such Benedictus shall not be played upon the organs, that the people may accustom themselves to the words of Holy Scripture. Thereupon a German psalm is sung, or a song made out of Holy Scripture, as is in Doctor Luther's little songbook.

Pomerania, *Kirchenordnung*, 1535 (Sehling 4, pp. 340–341):

The schoolmaster or cantor straightway beginneth the German Benedictus, the song of Zacharias, with the *differentia* of the seventh tone, with the antiphon only at the end, "Blessed be the Lord, the God of Israel" […]. Thereupon is sung a German psalm, "Have mercy on me," etc., or another. (Where there were good schools, a Latin introit might be sung at times.)

In Transylvania the German Benedictus replaced the Sunday procession that had been abolished; at Easter *Salve festa dies* (Hail, festal day) was kept. **Transylvanian Saxons, *Kirchenordnung*, 1547**, Latin text (Sehling 24, p. 223):

On the Lord's days, for the procession that is abolished, before the introit is sung the German canticle of Zacharias, *Benedictus Dominus* (Blessed be the Lord) […]; in Eastertide, *Salve festa dies*.

The German text of the same order (Sehling 24, p. 244):

On the Sunday, in the stead of the procession laid aside, the song of praise of Zacharias is sung, "Blessed be the Lord." At Easter, the *Salve festa dies*.

The Wittenberg order of 1533 puts the Benedictus before everything, then an introit, Latin or a German psalm. **Wittenberg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1533** (Sehling 1, p. 704):

Before all things in the Mass there shall be sung first the German Benedictus of Zacharias with its short antiphon, thereafter an introit, at times in Latin, at times in German, which shall be a German psalm.

In the Henneberg village of Sulzfeld the Benedictus was sung "in place of the introit". **Sulzfeld (Henneberg), 1566** (Sehling 2, p. 352):

In the stead of the introit the schoolmaster with the boys beginneth to sing the Benedictus of Zacharias in German, and thereupon the antiphon "Blessed be the Lord, the God of Israel," as the notes show.

8.4.4 The German Te Deum at the opening

In some later northern orders the German Te Deum ("Herr Gott, dich loben wir") opens the morning service. It was played on the organ, or sung verse by verse. **Hoya, *Kirchenordnung*, 1581** (Sehling 6/2, p. 1148):

And where there are organs, the organist shall begin to play "Lord God, we praise thee," etc. But where there is no organ, it shall be sung. And when that is ended, the pastor in his accustomed long gown shall step before the altar, put on the Mass vestment, and sing the introit of the season. Thereupon the organist playeth the Kyrie, and the choir singeth *Christe eleison*.

The East Frisian order of Marienhafe, which follows Hoya, begins with a German Kyrie sung kneeling, "Ach Vatter" (Ah Father), and then the Te Deum. **Marienhafe, *Kirchenordnung*, 1593** (Sehling 7/1, p. 695):

For the high sermon the schoolmaster with the boys shall be there at eight o'clock, and begin kneeling with the Kyrie "Ah Father," etc. […] Thereupon the organist shall begin the *Te Deum laudamus* (We praise thee, O God), and the choir together with the congregation shall sing the same in German devoutly, verse by verse, after the organ, etc. […] Thereafter yet a psalm or spiritual song, given out by the preacher, [shall be] played and sung.

The Hildesheim chapter lands opened with a choice of three: the German Te Deum, "Gott der Vater wohn uns bei" (God the Father, dwell with us) or "Nun freut euch" (Now rejoice), followed by "Allein Gott" (To God alone). **Hildesheim (Stift), *Kirchenordnung für Steuerwald und Peine*, 1561** (Sehling 7/2.1, p. 781):

[He shall] first sing the German *Te Deum laudamus*, or "God the Father be with us, and let us," etc., or "Now rejoice, dear Christians all"; thereupon "To God alone on high be glory."

Where a village pastor could not sing matins with his sexton, Pomerania had the German Te Deum sung "pro introitu" (for the introit). **Pomerania, *Agenda*, 1569** (Sehling 4, p. 440):

Where the pastor cannot sing matins with the sexton, as is before said, he shall yet sing for the introit the German *Te Deum laudamus*, with a collect.

8.4.5 A penitential psalm-hymn for the confession

In Hesse (Moderate Reformed) the congregation could sing Psalm 51 in Erhart Hegenwalt's metrical version ("Erbarm dich mein, o Herre Gott") in place of the spoken confession and absolution. **Hessen, *Kirchenordnung*, 1566** (Moderate Reformed; Sehling 8, p. 248):

Thereafter either the confession of sins is made, with the receiving of the absolution, or the whole church singeth the fifty-first psalm, "Have mercy on me, O Lord God," etc.

Wittgenstein used "Aus tiefer Not" (Out of deep distress) in the same way. **Wittgenstein, *Kirchenordnung* [1565]** (Sehling 22, p. 116):

and thereafter sing "Out of the depths I cry to thee," etc., as a confession, and after this read the sixth chapter of John or the fifty-third chapter of Isaiah, and then sing the creed, and following that step up into the pulpit.

8.4.6 A hymn to cover the priest's prayers at the altar step

In the Bugenhagen city order of Hildesheim the opening German psalm is sung while the priest kneels at the altar with the sexton and prays the preparatory prayers. **Hildesheim (city), *Kirchenordnung*, 1544** (Sehling 7/2.1, p. 852):

First one may sing before the introit a German psalm or song made out of Holy Scripture. During the song the priest goeth before the altar and kneeleth with the sexton, and prayeth for himself and for the people and for all the need of Christendom.

8.4.7 How fixed the opening was

The opening slot was the most stable in the corpus. Where a choice is named it is nearly always among these few:

- *Veni sancte Spiritus* (Come, Holy Spirit; Latin antiphon), or its German forms "Komm heiliger Geist, Herre Gott" (Come, Holy Ghost, Lord God; Luther's hymn) and "Komm, heiliger Geist, erfülle" (Come, Holy Ghost, fill; prose, sung to the Latin melody).
- "Nun bitten wir den heiligen Geist" (Now pray we the Holy Ghost).
- The German Benedictus.
- The German Te Deum.
- Psalm 51 ("Erbarm dich mein" or "O Herre Gott, begnade mich").

Only the grading by feast varies (§8.4.1). A few orders instead fill the slot with a seasonal song "pro ingressu" (for the entrance) at vespers (§8.16.2).

8.5 Hymns in place of the introit

The introit is a proper, and this chapter does not treat the Latin introits as such. But it is the proper most often replaced by a hymn. The rule is nearly everywhere the same. A Latin introit taken from Scripture might be kept where a school could sing it. Otherwise, and in the villages always, "a German psalm" was sung instead. In the 16th century a "German psalm" (*ein deutscher Psalm*) is any metrical hymn, above all Luther's psalm-hymns, and not only a paraphrase of a psalm.

8.5.1 The rule: a Scriptural introit, or a German psalm

Schleswig-Holstein, *Kirchenordnung*, 1542 (Sehling 23, p. 89):

First one may sing or read the introit, such as is not against the divine Scripture, but like unto those which are sung on the Sundays, and also on the feasts of Christ, taken out of the Psalter. In the villages one may sing a German psalm for the introit.

Buxtehude, *Kirchenordnung*, 1552 (Sehling 7/1, p. 74):

If the introit in the Mass be like unto Holy Scripture, it shall be kept on the feasts or holy days. But if the introit be not grounded in Scripture, or otherwise unserviceable to edification, then in the stead of the introit a German psalm shall be sung, as "Come, Holy Ghost," or else another at the bidding of the pastor. But on the working day a German psalm shall always be sung for the introit.

Prussia, *Artikel der Ceremonien*, 1525 (Sehling 4, p. 32). The German psalms already sung in place of the introit may stay until the new Latin schools can sing the Latin again:

but where the introits are done away and German psalms sung for them, let it also abide so, until, for the sake of the Latin schools set up, the Latin introit or the whole Latin psalm shall be ordained in their stead.

Riga, *Kirchenordnung*, 1530 (Sehling 5, p. 15). The reason for keeping some Latin is that "the tongues should not be put so wholly out of the church's use":

one might sing the Sunday introits in Latin for the exercise of the youth (when it shall now have increased in the school), or in the stead of the introit a psalm in German or Latin, namely this, "May God be gracious unto us," etc., or another; for the tongues should not be so wholly put out of the church's use.

Tecklenburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1543 (Sehling 22, p. 243):

In the stead of the introit shall be sung a German psalm of David, or the like, proved by God's word; next thereto the Kyrie eleison and *Gloria in excelsis* in German.

The Calenberg order replaces all four chants of the village Mass with a single psalm. **Calenberg-Göttingen, *Kirchenordnung*, 1542** (Sehling 6/2, p. 795):

Accordingly the pastors shall sing, in the stead of the introit, the *Et in terra* (And on earth), the alleluia and the sequence, a psalm for each.

The same rule reached the Bohemian villages of Teschen. **Teschen, *Kirchenordnung*, 1584** (Sehling 3, p. 462):

But in the villages one may otherwise sing a song or psalm in the stead of the introit, in German or Bohemian.

In the Albertine order the whole communion service of the villages begins with a hymn "pro introitu" (for the introit). **Saxony (Albertine), *Kirchenordnung*, 1539** (Sehling 1, p. 272):

When there are communicants, the people shall be made to sing a fine psalm or else a spiritual song, for the introit.

8.5.2 Which hymns: a short rotating list

Where the orders name the hymns for this slot, they give a short list, and several say plainly that the list is to be rotated. The favourites are Luther's and his circle's penitential and psalm-hymns: "Es wolt uns Gott genädig sein" (May God be gracious to us; Ps 67), "Erbarm dich mein, o Herre Gott" (Have mercy on me, O Lord God; Ps 51), "Aus tiefer Not" (Out of deep distress; Ps 130), "Ach Gott vom Himmel sieh darein" (O God, look down from heaven; Ps 12), "Wär Gott nicht mit uns" (Were God not with us at this time; Ps 124), "Es spricht der Unweisen Mund" (The mouth of the unwise says indeed; Ps 14), and "Komm heiliger Geist, Herre Gott" (Come, Holy Ghost, Lord God).

Prussia, *Kirchenordnung*, 1544 (Sehling 4, p. 64):

At the beginning, in the stead of the introit, one of the German psalms is sung, as hath been done hitherto here in the duchy, namely: "May God be gracious unto us"; "Have mercy on me, O Lord God"; "Out of the depths"; "Ah God, from heaven look down"; "Were God not with us at this time"; "The mouth of the unwise saith indeed," etc., and the like psalms, to be changed about one after another. But on feasts, as Easter, Pentecost, Christmas, let the proper introits be sung, in German or Latin according to the occasion of the place, for the exercise of the youth.

Naumburg, *Kirchen-Ordnung* for St Wenzel, 1537/1538 (Sehling 2, p. 71) alternates three hymns Sunday by Sunday, and keeps sung Latin introits in part-music for the feasts:

For the introit is sung, one Sunday after another: "Come, Holy Ghost," etc.; "Have mercy on me," etc.; "Out of the depths," etc. But on the high feasts one singeth in measured music, as at Christmas the introit *Puer natus*, or *Dies est laetitiae* (It is a day of gladness), etc.; Palm Sunday, *Gloria, laus et honor* (Glory, praise and honour); Easter, *Salve festa dies* (Hail, festal day), etc.; Pentecost, the introit of the Holy Ghost; Trinity, the introit of the Trinity; the Annunciation of Mary, *Haec est dies* (This is the day), etc.

The St George's order of Nördlingen (1555) copies this rotation, putting it after the Latin introit and before the confession (Sehling 12, p. 319). The *Auctuarium* of Brandenburg-Ansbach, an Interim order, gives the fullest village list. **Brandenburg-Ansbach, *Auctuarium*, 1548** (Interim order; Sehling 11, pp. 329–330):

Where there are no schools, or folk that could sing Latin, the pastors shall sing with the people in the stead of the introit: "Now rejoice, dear Christians all," etc.; "These are the holy ten commandments," etc.; "Have mercy on me, O Lord God," etc.; […] "I call to thee, Lord Jesu Christ," etc.

In the Pomeranian orders of 1542 and 1569 the choice is Latin introit or Psalm 51, in one of its two German versions. **Pomerania, *Kirchenordnung*, 1542** (Sehling 4, p. 356):

[they] begin the introit in Latin, or sing a German psalm for it, "Have mercy on me," in the melody as it standeth in the printed songbooks, or the psalm "O Lord God, be gracious unto me," etc.

Pomerania, *Agenda*, 1569 (Sehling 4, p. 437):

At the beginning the choir singeth the introit of the feast or of the season, or of the Sunday; or "Come, Holy Ghost, Lord God"; "Have mercy on me"; "O Lord God, be gracious unto me," etc.; or another German psalm.

8.5.3 Early German Masses: a hymn as the introit itself

In some of the earliest German Masses a hymn stands where the introit stood, under the heading *Introitus* (Introit). The Nürnberg hospital Mass of Andreas Döber prints "Nun bitten wir" (Now pray we) with the heading "Introit, or entrance of the Mass". **Nürnberg, Döber's German Mass in the New Hospital, 1525** (Sehling 11, p. 56):

Introit, or entrance of the Mass. [Notes] "Now pray we the Holy Ghost" [four verses].

Strasbourg's Mass of 1525 (Moderate Reformed) had Psalm 51 or Psalm 130 "in place of the Introit". **Strasbourg, *Ordnung des Herren Nachtmal*, 1525** (Moderate Reformed; Sehling 20/1, p. 156):

Thereupon the church beginneth to sing a psalm, as the Miserere or another psalm, in the stead of the introit, and sometimes the Kyrie eleison and *Gloria in excelsis*. The hundred and thirtieth psalm, *De profundis*, sometimes in the stead of the introit in the Mass: "Out of the depths I cry to thee."

A Low German Mass from Lippe gives "Uth deper nodt" (Out of deep distress I cry to thee) as the introit, with the choice of any other psalm. **Lippe, *Deutsche Messe* [c. 1525–1538]** (Sehling 22, p. 565):

But while the priest readeth the *Confiteor* (I confess), the choir singeth the introit of the Mass. Introit of the Mass: "Out of the depths I cry to thee," etc., or another psalm, whichever one will. Item, now at this time the choir or people commonly sing before the introit the antiphon *Veni sancte Spiritus*, "Come, Holy Ghost."

8.5.4 A hymn of the feast for the introit

On feasts, some orders let a hymn of the feast replace the Latin festal introit. Mecklenburg sang Luther's Christmas *Leise* (Leise (a vernacular hymn ending Kyrieleis)) "Ein Kindelein so löbelich" (A little child so praiseworthy; the four stanzas of "Der Tag, der ist so freudenreich" [The day that is so full of joy]) at Candlemas and on the Sundays between Christmas and Candlemas. **Mecklenburg, *Ordeninge der misse*, 1545** (Sehling 5, p. 151):

On the day of the Purification let the four fair verses, "A little Child," etc., be sung for an introit. The same shall also be sung for an introit in the villages on the Sundays between Christmas and Candlemas; on which Sundays in the towns the office *Puer natus* may be sung at times.

Wittgenstein kept the Latin introits of the high feasts but allowed three hymns in their place: "Der Tag, der ist so freudenreich" for *Puer natus*, "Christ lag in Todesbanden" (Christ lay in death's bonds) for *Resurrexi*, and "Es ist das Heil" (Salvation has come to us) for *Spiritus Domini* (The Spirit of the Lord). **Wittgenstein, *Kirchenordnung*, 1563** (Sehling 22, p. 102):

[they shall] after the *Veni sancte* sing the customary introit, as these are: *Puer natus est nobis* (Unto us a child is born), etc., *Resurrexi et adhuc tecum sum* (I am risen and am still with thee), etc., *Spiritus Domini replevit orbem terrarum* (The Spirit of the Lord hath filled the world), etc.; which may also be learned and sung in German in the villages, or, in the stead of the same, may be used: "The day that is so full of joy," etc., "Christ lay in the bands of death," etc., "Salvation now is come to us," etc.

In the Henneberg village of Sulzfeld the chorus sang the Christmas song "Ein Kind geboren zu Bethlehem" (*Puer natus in Bethlehem*) instead of the introit, and "Also heilig ist der Tag" (Thus holy is this day) three times at Easter and Ascension. **Sulzfeld and Klein-Bardorf, *Kirchen-Ordnung*, 1566** (Sehling 2, p. 353):

At Christmas, in the stead of the introit, the choir singeth "A Child is born in Bethlehem"; but at Easter and the Ascension, "So holy is the day," etc., three times; and in the stead of the psalm between the chapters the customary songs of the feasts are sung.

The Hamburg order of 1529 lists the Latin introits for the feasts it keeps. For other feasts, where there is no chant from Scripture, it allows "joyful psalms and songs". **Hamburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1529** (Sehling 5, p. 528):

First is sung a German psalm, or on certain feasts [an introit] in Latin: from Christmas unto the Purification, *Puer natus*; between Easter and the Ascension, *Salus populi ego sum*; thereafter unto Pentecost, *Viri Galilaei*; from Pentecost, *Spiritus Domini*; of St John, *Ne timeas, Zacharia* […]; of St Michael, *Benedicite Domino*. On feasts whereof one hath no proper chant out of Scripture, one may well sing joyful psalms and songs.

8.5.5 A German prose antiphon as introit

Ritzebüttel, in Hamburg's territory, sang the prose German "Komm, heiliger Geist, erfülle" (Come, Holy Ghost, fill) with its Alleluia "in place of the introit". **Ritzebüttel, *Kirchenordnung*, 1556** (Sehling 5, p. 557):

On the Sunday one beginneth first to sing, in the stead of the introit, the German song "Come, Holy Ghost, fill the hearts of thy faithful, and kindle in them the fire of thy divine love" […] Alleluia.

8.5.6 Why a short list: that the people might learn them

The Halle order explains the aim of the rotation. The German psalms sung "pro introitu" (for the introit) were to be chosen so that the whole church might become sure of some good psalms, and in time of the whole Psalter, as at Jena. **Halle, *Kirchen-Ordnung der christlichen Gemein*, 1543** (Sehling 2, p. 436):

When "Out of the depths" or other German psalms are sung for the introit, the same shall be so ordered that the whole church may become surely accustomed to some good, comfortable, profitable psalms; and in time it might be brought about that the people, by such diligent exercise, using the psalms one after another, should grow accustomed to all the psalms in the whole Psalter, as hath been profitably set up in some churches, as at Jena and other places.

Nördlingen dropped the introit altogether when the psalm after the epistle was a long one, and in winter "for the cold and for beloved brevity's sake". **Nördlingen, *Kirchenordnung*, 1579** (Sehling 12, p. 375):

But where a long psalm falleth, as "Our Father," "Now rejoice, dear Christians all," "Salvation now is come to us," "Through Adam's fall," "Where God the Lord standeth not by us," and the like, then the singing of the introit is left out, and the organist alone playeth. But especially in the winter season the introit shall be left out, for the cold's sake and for beloved brevity's sake.

8.5.7 How fixed the slot was

Where a German hymn replaced the introit, the choice was among **a handful**, usually rotated. The core was "Komm heiliger Geist" (Come, Holy Ghost), Psalm 51, Psalm 130 and Psalm 67, with a few other psalm-hymns. At the high feasts the Latin introit returned, or a hymn of the feast took its place. No order found assigns a different introit-hymn to each Sunday of the year, as the Latin propers had done.

8.6 The Kyrie: plain, in three tongues, troped and German

The Kyrie is an ordinary, not a proper, so it was not replaced by a hymn in the way the introit was. But it was sung in German, it was troped in German, and it was graded by season, like the medieval Kyrie melodies. Most orders cut it back to three petitions, one to each Person of the Trinity. The Kyrie melodies of the chant books (*summum*, *paschale*, *dominicale*, *angelicum*, *apostolicum*, *in adventu*, *de beata Virgine*) survived as seasonal grades in the Lutheran cantionals of Spangenberg and Lossius. The grades themselves are treated in Chapter 12 §12.4.2. This section deals with the texts sung to them.

The Kyrie in the order of the Mass, and the seasonal Kyrie chants named in the orders, are treated in Chapter 2, §2.6.

8.6.1 Three times, not nine

Luther's *Deutsche Messe* (German Mass) already prescribed the Kyrie "three times and not nine times" (Sehling 1, p. 14). The Wolfenbüttel order gives the reason: once for each Person of the Trinity. **Wolfenbüttel, *Kirchenordnung*, 1543** (Sehling 6/1, p. 54):

It is not needful to repeat the *eleison* or Kyrie nine times; it is enough to sing it three times, in the name of the Father and of the Son and of the Holy Ghost, without organs.

Wittenberg kept a nine-fold Kyrie for the feasts. After the plain three-fold Kyrie there was no Gloria. **Wittenberg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1533** (Sehling 1, p. 704):

Thereafter the right Kyrie three times; or at times, especially on the feasts, another nine times, as is customary. After the plain Kyrie one singeth not *Gloria in excelsis Deo* (Glory to God in the highest), but after the others, when one will, and especially on the feasts.

8.6.2 In three tongues

Two Baltic orders have the three petitions sung in three languages: Greek, Latin and German. **Prussia, *Artikel der Ceremonien*, 1525** (Sehling 4, p. 32):

Of the Kyrie eleison it is thought good, since it is sung three times, that it be sung in three tongues, as is also the custom here: Greek, Latin and German.

Riga, *Kirchenordnung*, 1530 (Sehling 5, p. 15):

After the introit the Kyrie eleison is sung with few notes (save on the high feasts, when the Easter note may be taken). And it were not unseemly that it be sung in three tongues, Greek, Latin and German, as is the custom in some places, since it is sung three times.

A Westphalian order prints such Kyries, several of them, to be chosen by the season. The first acclamation keeps the Greek, the second is in Latin, and only the third is in the people's tongue. **Neuenrade, *Kirchenordnung*, 1564** (Sehling 22, p. 527):

After the *Te Deum* (We praise thee, O God), when the confession hath been spoken by the priest before the altar, the Kyrie is sung, etc. Here are several set one after another, of which one taketh whichever he will, according to the occasion of the season: *Kyrie eleison*. *Christe miserere* [Christ, have mercy]. O Lord, have mercy upon us. Another: *Kyrie eleison*. *Christe miserere*. O Lord, have mercy upon us. *Paschale*: *Kyrie eleison*. *Christe miserere*. O Lord, have mercy upon us.

A fourth of the same form stands before the German prose Gloria (p. 528).

8.6.3 Bugenhagen's defence of the Greek Kyrie

Bugenhagen defended keeping the Greek words, even in German. The people already sang *Kyrieleis* at the end of their best-loved hymns. **Braunschweig, *Kirchenordnung*, 1528** (Sehling 6/1, p. 438):

To make a German text out of Latin or other holy Scripture, with a seemly tune, is not every man's work; to set up an unlovely singing is no art. Why should one not sing the Kyrie eleison in the Mass? For it is sung in other songs, as are: "God be praised," "In the midst of life," "These are the holy ten commandments," "Man, wilt thou live blessedly," "Christ is arisen," "Now pray we the Holy Ghost," "Praised be thou, Jesu Christ," etc.

8.6.4 Troped Kyries

A troped Kyrie lengthens each acclamation with words of its own. The medieval Latin Kyries were of this kind, and were named after their tropes: the *Kyrie fons bonitatis* after its opening words, "Kyrie, fount of goodness". Sehling's editors gloss the names, in the hymn register of volume 12, as "various melodies of the Kyrie of the Mass with tropes, that is, texts set under them, which were dropped in the Catholic Church at the reform of the Missal, but kept in the evangelical service" (Sehling 12, p. 412).

The orders kept the names and the melodies, and set German words to them. Each German Kyrie has three petitions, one to each Person of the Trinity, and lengthens each with a clause or a rhymed couplet, which mostly ends in *eleison* or "have mercy upon us". The Naumburg order of 1537/1538 has three, "according to the occasion of the season", and names them by their Latin melodies: the *paschale* (Easter [Kyrie]), the *Fons bonitatis* (Fount of goodness) and the *Magnus Deus* (Great God; Sehling 2, p. 71). It prints all three in its order of "the high office on the holy day", whose collect and epistle are those of Pentecost, and there the *Fons bonitatis* is called the *summum* (the highest [chant]; p. 78). The St George's order of Nördlingen (1555), which follows Naumburg closely and often word for word (Sehling 12, p. 318, n. 1), takes the three over and gives each its season (Sehling 12, p. 318):

Kyrie	Its German text at Naumburg	From	Until
paschale	"O Herre Gott, Vater in Ewigkeit" (O Lord God, Father in eternity; §8.6.4.2)	Easter	Pentecost
Fons bonitatis	"Kyrie, Gott Vater in Ewigkeit" (Kyrie, God the Father in eternity; §8.6.4.1)	Pentecost	Christmas
Magne Deus (Great God)	"O Vater, allmächtiger Gott" (O Father, almighty God; §8.6.4.3)	Christmas	Easter

The texts follow, one Kyrie to a subsection, each in the original and in English:

§	Kyrie	Sung to	Text printed in	Named or begun in
8.6.4.1	"Kyrie, Gott Vater in Ewigkeit"	*summum*, *Fons bonitatis*	Naumburg 1537/1538	Nördlingen 1555; Herpf and Obermassfeld 1566; Hof 1592
8.6.4.2	"O Herre Gott, Vater in Ewigkeit"	*paschale*	Naumburg 1537/1538	Nördlingen 1555; Wasungen 1566
8.6.4.3	"O Vater, allmächtiger Gott"	*Magne Deus*	Naumburg 1537/1538	Nördlingen 1555; Hof 1592

§	Kyrie	Sung to	Text printed in	Named or begun in
8.6.4.4	"Ach Vater, allerhöchster Gott" (Ah Father, God most high)	*summum*	Ritzebüttel 1556, in Low German	Mecklenburg 1545; Marienhafe 1593
8.6.4.5	"Here, o Godt vader yn ewicheit" (Lord, O God the Father in eternity) and "Kyrie, milde vader" (Kyrie, gentle Father)	—	Schleswig-Holstein [after 1526]; Ritzebüttel 1556	—
8.6.4.6	"Kyrie, Gott aller Welt Schöpfer und Vater" (Kyrie, God, Creator of all the world, and Father)	*paschale*	—	Pfalz-Zweibrücken 1557
8.6.4.7	The Latin tropes: the Holy Week Kyrie; the *Fons bonitatis* and the *Magne Deus*	—	Hof 1592; the other two from outside the corpus	Buxtehude 1565; Nördlingen 1579

8.6.4.1 "Kyrie, Gott Vater in Ewigkeit": the *summum* or *Fons bonitatis*

Naumburg prints the text first of its three, under the name *summum* (the highest [chant]), with the notes. **Naumburg, *Kirchen-Ordnung* for St Wenzel, 1537/1538** (Sehling 2, p. 78):

Hereupon the whole choir singeth the Kyrie eleison as followeth. *Kyrie summum*.

Kyrie, God the Father in eternity, great is thy mercy, of all things the Creator and Ruler, *eleison*.

Christ, comfort of all the world, thou alone hast redeemed sinners; O Jesu, Son of God, our Mediator thou art in the highest throne; to thee we cry out of the desire of [our] heart, *eleison*.

Kyrie, God the Holy Ghost, comfort [and] strengthen us in faith at all times, that at the last end we may depart joyfully out of this misery, *eleison*.

The Latin trope of the *Fons bonitatis* (Fount of goodness), which no order prints, is given from outside the corpus in §8.6.4.7. The German does not translate it.

Hof sings the same text under the name of its Latin melody, on Whitsunday. **Hof, *Ordo ecclesiasticus*, 1592** (Sehling 11, p. 441):

On the feast of Pentecost. Introit: "The whole world is full of the Spirit," etc. *Kyrie fons bonitatis*: "Kyrie, God the Father in eternity." In the place of *Et in terra* (And on earth): "All honour and praise shall be God's."

Nördlingen sings the *Kyrie summum* at Pentecost and on Trinity Sunday (Sehling 12, pp. 321–322; quoted in §12.4.2). In the Henneberg parishes it was the German Kyrie of the Sunday communion, "the fair Christian song". **Obermassfeld (Henneberg), *Kirchen-Ordnung*, 1566** (Sehling 2, p. 343):

When communicants are present, the schoolmaster with the boys and the church singeth first the fair Christian song "Kyrie, God the Father in eternity, great is thy mercy," etc. Following thereupon, the *Gloria in excelsis Deo*, as the same is also set in German as a song: "To God alone on high be glory and thanks for his grace," etc. But where no communicants are present we sing "Come, Holy Ghost, Lord God."

At Herpf the German *summum* could give way to the Kyrie of the feast. **Herpf (Henneberg), 1566** (Sehling 2, p. 334):

When there are communicants, the Benedictus is sung in German, thereupon also the German *Kyrie eleison summum*, or that of the present feast.

8.6.4.2 "O Herre Gott, Vater in Ewigkeit": the *paschale*

The *paschale* (Easter [Kyrie]) is the shortest of the three. Its petitions are prayers, without the *eleison*. **Naumburg, *Kirchen-Ordnung* for St Wenzel, 1537/1538** (Sehling 2, p. 78):

Kyrie paschale (Easter Kyrie).

O Lord God, Father in eternity, be gracious unto us sinners.

Christ, Saviour of the world and its comfort, make us all free from sins.

O God the Holy Ghost, impart unto us wisdom, love and faith most of all; bring godly righteousness.

At Wasungen, on Sundays and feasts without communicants, the school sang a psalm "with the three short Kyries hung thereto in German". Their opening is that of the *paschale*, with "Father of all mercy" for "Father in eternity"; the identification is this book's. **Wasungen (Henneberg), pastor's report, 1566** (Sehling 2, p. 356):

At the beginning the school singeth the German litany, or else a fairly long psalm, as the Our Father or "Through Adam's fall," or, with the three short Kyries hung thereto in German, "O Lord God, Father of all mercy, be gracious unto us sinners," etc.

At Hof the *paschale* is sung from Easter to the Ascension to the words that the order gives under its notes, "Lord, have mercy upon us": the plain German Kyrie, not a troped one (Sehling 11, pp. 439–441).

8.6.4.3 "O Vater, allmächtiger Gott": the *Magne Deus*

The third Naumburg Kyrie ends each petition with "have mercy upon us". **Naumburg, *Kirchen-Ordnung* for St Wenzel, 1537/1538** (Sehling 2, p. 78):

Kyrie magne Deus (Kyrie, Great God).

O Father, almighty God, to thee we cry in [our] need; by thy great mercy have mercy upon us.

Christ, be pleased to hear us; for us art thou born of Mary; have mercy upon us.

Lord, forgive us our sins, help us in the last hour, thou who for us hast died; have mercy upon us.

Hof sings it from Christmas to Epiphany: on Christmas Day, on the Sunday after Christmas, at the Circumcision and on the Sunday after it, and at Epiphany (Sehling 11, pp. 433–434). It gives the German incipit under the name of the Latin trope. **Hof, *Ordo ecclesiasticus*, 1592** (Sehling 11, p. 433):

Kyrie magnae Deus potentiae (Kyrie, O God of great power): "O Father, almighty God."

The register of the Hof volume refers the text to a song of Johann Spangenberg, of which Hof takes the first, fourth and eighth stanzas (Wackernagel III, no. 1116), and calls it an expanded rewriting of the *Kyrie magnae Deus potentiae* (Sehling 11, p. 752). The Latin trope is given from outside the corpus in §8.6.4.7. By this book's reading, the German first line renders its opening, *magnae Deus potentiae* (God of great power), and the Christe "born of Mary" recalls its "only Son of [thy] mother"; the rest is free. Hof's list of figured music sets the Latin *Kyrie Magnae Deus potentiae* for four voices on St Stephen's Day and at Epiphany (p. 458). Nördlingen sings the *Magne Deus* (Great God) from Christmas to Easter, and again at the Annunciation, "and on that day the organ is played too" (Sehling 12, pp. 318, 322).

8.6.4.4 "Ach Vater, allerhöchster Gott"

In Mecklenburg the German *Kyrie summum* was "Ach vader, alder högeste godt" (Ah Father, God most high), to be taught to the villages. **Mecklenburg, *Ordeninge der misse*, 1545** (Sehling 5, p. 151):

The German *Kyrie summum*, "Ah Father, God most high," the parsons shall sing in the villages, and teach it to the people, that the whole church may sing it. The sexton can do great good herein, if he keep not out of the way, nor (as some do) go and lie upon the altar, but turn himself at times in the choir toward the church and sing it well before the people. The *Kyrie paschale*, *Kyrie angelicum*, *dominicale* (Sunday [Kyrie]) and the others may also at times be sung in the towns.

"Ach Vater" (Ah Father) was still the opening Kyrie at Marienhafe in East Frisia in 1593, sung kneeling (§8.4.4). Sehling's editors identify the Marienhafe Kyrie as "a particular, troped Kyrie", from Johann Spangenberg's *Cantiones ecclesiasticae latinae … Kirchengesenge Deudsch* (Latin church songs … German church songs) of 1545 (Wackernagel III, no. 1114). It stands in the Emden *Enchiridion* of 1589 as "Kyrie, Ah Father, thou most high God, how little is thy commandment regarded" (Sehling 7/1, p. XVII, adding to p. 695, n. 9). Those are the opening words of the second Kyrie of Ritzebüttel, whose first line has "Lord God the Father" for "Ah Father"; the identification is this book's. **Ritzebüttel, *Kirchenordnung*, 1556** (Sehling 5, p. 557):

Another Kyrie eleison, thus:

Lord God the Father, God most high, how little is thy commandment regarded! Spare our blindness, which doeth many sins; have mercy upon us.

Christ, who art the way and the true light, the gate of truth, and the life, the Father's counsel and word, whom he hath given us for a comfort, have mercy upon us.

Lord, Holy Ghost in eternity, stand by us through thy mercy; our sins are grievous unto us; [we] will not forsake thee, in thee [we] hope; have mercy upon us.

8.6.4.5 The other Low German Kyries: Schleswig-Holstein and Ritzebüttel

A Low German manuscript Mass from Schleswig-Holstein, written after 1526, has a troped Kyrie with its notes (§7.11.1). After it come the opening of the Gloria, where the text breaks off, and a plain *Kyrie dominicale*. **Schleswig-Holstein, *Deutsche Messe* [after 1526]** (Sehling 23, p. 56):

Lord, O God the Father in eternity, who livest and reignest over all, have mercy upon us.

Christ, who hast loosed the band of death, have mercy upon us.

Lord, O Holy Ghost, who proceedest from the Father and the Son and art praised as God alike, have mercy upon us.

[…] *Kyrie dominicale*: Lord God the Father, have mercy upon us. Christ, have mercy upon us. Lord, Holy Ghost, have mercy upon us.

The Ritzebüttel order gives three German Kyries, "each with its own melody": a plain one, "Ach Vater" (Ah Father; §8.6.4.4) and a third, lightly troped. **Ritzebüttel, *Kirchenordnung*, 1556** (Sehling 5, p. 557):

Thereafter the Kyrie eleison is sung with notes in the German tongue thus: Lord God the Father, have mercy upon us. Christ, God the Son, have mercy upon us. Lord God, Holy Ghost, have mercy upon us. […] Another Kyrie, thus:

Kyrie, gentle Father, we all pray thee, Father, have mercy upon us.

Christ, our King and Lord, have mercy upon us.

Kyrie, Holy Ghost, who art a comforter of the fainthearted, have mercy upon us.

Each with its own melody.

The same order speaks of a *missa dominicalis* (Sunday Mass), *paschalis* (Easter), *pentecostes* (of Pentecost) and *nativitatis* (of the Nativity): seasonal sets of Kyrie and Gloria.

8.6.4.6 Pfalz-Zweibrücken: "Kyrie, Gott aller Welt Schöpfer und Vater"

The songbook appended to the Pfalz-Zweibrücken *Kirchenordnung* (church order) of 1557 has three German Kyries, each paired with a German Gloria. The edition gives only the headings and first lines of its songs (Sehling 18, p. 247, n. 791). As far as the first lines show, only the third, the *paschale* (Easter [Kyrie]), is troped. **Pfalz-Zweibrücken, *Kirchenordnung*, 1557**, songbook (Sehling 18, p. 248):

Here followeth the Kyrie eleison with the *Gloria in excelsis*: "Kyrie eleison, Lord have mercy." *Gloria in excelsis*: "Glory be to God on high, and on earth peace." Another Kyrie and *Et in terra* (And on earth): "Lord, have mercy upon us." "Glory be to God on high." *Kyrie paschale* (Easter Kyrie): "Kyrie, God, Creator of all the world, and Father, *eleison*." *Gloria in excelsis Deo* (Glory to God in the highest): "All honour and praise shall be God's."

The editor refers each to the *Handbuch der deutschen evangelischen Kirchenmusik* (Handbook of German Evangelical Church Music); the *paschale* is its no. 34 (Sehling 18, p. 248, n. 795).

8.6.4.7 The Latin tropes

The Latin troped Kyries were sung where there were Latin schools, but the orders seldom print their words.

Printed, but left out of the edition. The Buxtehude *Agende* of 1565 heads the first of its Kyries "on the highest feasts and on the Sunday of the Trinity, with the text": the Kyrie of the highest feasts, with its trope (§12.4.2). Its source marks several forms of the Kyrie by text and melody, after Lucas Lossius's *Psalmodia* (Wittenberg, 1561). Sehling's editor left the texts out, since "without the notes and without the *Psalmodia* of Lossius" they seemed meaningless (Sehling 7/1, p. 123, n. 70).

Named by their opening words. The Nördlingen order of 1579 lists the Latin chants for the weekday office and vespers. For Advent it names the Kyrie *Fons bonitatis* (Fount of goodness) by three of its tropes. **Nördlingen, *Kirchenordnung*, 1579** (Sehling 12, p. 377):

A register of the Latin chants that are to be sung in the week, in the office and at vespers. The first Sunday in Advent. Introit: *Ad te, Domine, levavi animam meam* [Unto thee, O Lord, do I lift up my soul]. Kyrie: *Fons bonitatis* [Fount of goodness]. *Christe, unice Dei patris genite* [Christ, only-begotten of God the Father]. Kyrie: *Ignis divine* [O fire divine]. The collect in German.

The three are the opening words of the first Kyrie, the first Christe and the last Kyrie of the troped *Kyrie fons bonitatis*, verses 1a, 2a and 3c of the Latin text given below. Some late medieval sources have these three verses only (*Analecta Hymnica* 47, notes to no. 5). The register of the edition lists "Kyrie Ignis divine" as a Kyrie of its own (Sehling 12, p. 412). The same list has the *Magne Deus* (Great God) from Christmas to the second Sunday after Epiphany and again in Lent, the *dominicale* (Sunday [Kyrie]) from Septuagesima to Lent and from Pentecost to the third Sunday after Trinity, and the *paschale* (Easter [Kyrie]) from Easter to Pentecost. From the third Sunday after Epiphany, and from the fourth after Trinity, it has "the Kyrie without the text", that is, without its tropes (Sehling 12, pp. 377–380).

Printed in full. One Latin troped Kyrie is printed whole in the corpus. At Hof the Holy Week Matins survived as "the evening office, formerly called Tenebrae", on the Wednesday, Thursday and Friday of Holy Week (§13.23.4). After the sermon the Kyrie was sung with three tropes, each sung by a master of the school, between the acclamations of the boys. **Hof, *Ordo ecclesiasticus*, 1592** (Sehling 11, p. 416):

VII. The Kyrie eleison with tropes is added in this manner, by the masters, the boys and the whole choir. Note: the schoolmaster and the cantor sing these tropes, one of the other colleagues being joined to them each day: on the first day the rector, the conrector [and] the cantor; on the second day the cantor, the rector and the third colleague; on the third day the fourth colleague, the cantor and the rector.

A boy: Kyrie eleison. The tropes. The first colleague of the school: Thou who didst prophetically promise, I will be thy death, O death [Hos 13:14]: Lord, have mercy! Christ the Lord became obedient unto death [Phil 2:8].

A boy: Kyrie eleison. Another boy: Christe eleison. The second colleague: Thou who, with thine hands stretched out upon the cross, hast drawn all the ages unto thee: Lord, have mercy! As above.

A boy: Kyrie eleison. Another boy: Christe eleison. A third boy: Kyrie eleison. The third colleague: Life dieth upon the tree, hell is despoiled by the bite. Lord, have mercy! Christ, as above.

The refrain is the verse that ends the psalms of the same office (Sehling 11, p. 416): "Christ became obedient for us unto death". The "bite" of the third trope answers the rest of the verse of Hosea in the Latin Bible: "O hell, I will be thy bite". The editor refers the form to the *Handbuch der deutschen evangelischen Kirchenmusik* (Handbook of German Evangelical Church Music; vol. I/1, no. 10; Sehling 11, p. 416, n. 20).

The *Fons bonitatis* and the *Magne Deus*, from outside the corpus. The orders name these two Kyries but nowhere print their Latin words. They are translated here from the critical edition of the medieval Kyrie tropes, *Analecta Hymnica Medii Aevi*, vol. 47, by Clemens Blume and Henry Marriott Bannister (Leipzig, 1905), with its numbering of the verses: three Kyries (1a–c), three Christes (2a–c) and three Kyries (3a–c). Its text is made from medieval manuscripts and printed missals. It has not been compared with Lossius's *Psalmodia* or the other Lutheran chant books from which the schools sang. Unlike the other quotations in this book, these two do not come from `eko.db` (Conventions).

Kyrie fons bonitatis (*Analecta Hymnica* 47, no. 5, pp. 53–56):

1a. Kyrie, fount of goodness, Father unbegotten, from whom all good things proceed, *eleison*.

1b. Kyrie, who didst send thy Son to suffer for the sin of the world, that he might save it, *eleison*.

1c. Kyrie, who givest the gifts of the sevenfold Spirit, by whom heaven [and] earth are filled, *eleison*.

2a. Christ, only-begotten of God the Father, whom the holy prophets wonderfully foretold to the world as to be born of a virgin, *eleison*.

2b. Christ, holy one, master of the palace of heaven, to whom the highest of the angels, standing ever by, singeth the song of glory as its office, *eleison*.

2c. Christ, be present from heaven at our prayers, whom with lowly minds we devoutly worship on earth; to thee, O gracious Jesu, we cry: *eleison*.

3a. Kyrie, gracious Spirit, at one with the Father and the Son, being of one substance, breathing from both, *eleison*.

3b. Kyrie, who, when Christ was baptized in the water of Jordan, didst appear shining in the form of a dove [Matt 3:16], *eleison*.

3c. Kyrie, O fire divine, kindle our hearts, that being worthy we may together proclaim evermore: *eleison*.

Analecta Hymnica reads "as its office" in 2b, where many sources have "before the Godhead". The German "Kyrie, Gott Vater in Ewigkeit" (Kyrie, God the Father in eternity), sung to this melody (§8.6.4.1), does not translate the trope; it keeps only its order of the Father, the Son and the Holy Ghost.

Kyrie magnae Deus potentiae (*Analecta Hymnica* 47, no. 99, pp. 158–160):

1a. Kyrie, God of great power, deliverer of man, the transgressor of the commandment, *eleison*.

1b. Kyrie, wonderful one, who didst send thy Son, born of a virgin, to redeem [us]: graciously have mercy upon us.

1c. Kyrie, glorious one, who for the lost sheep didst take upon thee human flesh, *eleison*.

2a. Christ, begotten of the Father most high, our salvation and life, *eleison*.

2b. Christ, only Son of [thy] mother, the truth, the peace and the way, *eleison*.

2c. Christ, hope of mercy, light appearing in light, *eleison*.

3a. Kyrie, whose Son Emmanuel ploweth up this that Adam, the first man, overthrew; *eleison*.

3b. Kyrie most holy, whom the wise men, when they had seen the star, worship with gifts offered [Matt 2:10–11], *eleison*.

3c. Kyrie, who in Jordan, when the King was baptized, appearedst in the form of a dove [Matt 3:16], *eleison*.

In 3a several sources have "restored this that Adam, the first man, lost", and "born man" for "whose Son". *Analecta Hymnica* prefers "whose Son" because the last three verses seem to be addressed to the Father, the Son and the Holy Ghost in turn. The trope's verses on the Nativity, the wise men and the baptism in Jordan fit the season that Hof and Nördlingen give it, from Christmas into the weeks after Epiphany (§8.6.4.3). *Analecta Hymnica* also notes that the trope's opening is recorded in the Bremen Missal printed at Strasbourg in 1511 (*Analecta Hymnica* 47, p. 160).

8.6.5 The Kyrie and Gloria in one hymn: "Allein Gott"

In East Frisia the German Kyrie and Gloria together were sung "as it is sung in the song *Allein Gott in der Höh sei Ehr*".
Ostfriesland, *Kirchenordnung*, 1535 (Sehling 7/1, p. 376):

First shall be sung one or two German psalms. Thereafter let the Kyrie eleison together with the *Gloria in excelsis* be sung in German, as it is sung in the song "To God alone on high be glory."

8.6.6 How fixed the Kyrie was

The Kyrie was **fixed by grade**. Its text hardly changed. Its melody changed with the season and the rank of the day, where a school could sing the grades. In the villages there was one German Kyrie, or three at most, rotated by season. No order found fits the Kyrie to the gospel of the day. It is the most calendar-bound and least topical of the sung ordinaries.

8.7 The Gloria: "Allein Gott in der Höh" and "All Ehr und Lob"

Two German Gloria hymns run through the orders:

- Nikolaus Decius's "Allein Gott in der Höh sei Ehr" (To God alone on high be glory), which reached the north first in Low German ("Allene Gade in der hoge sy ere", To God alone on high be glory).
- Luther's rhymed *Et in terra* (And on earth), "All Ehr und Lob soll Gottes sein" (All honour and praise shall be God's).

The priest's Latin or German intonation ("Gloria in excelsis Deo", "Glory be to God on high") usually stayed. The hymn was sung for, or together with, the choir's *Et in terra*.

Sehling's editors take "Allein Gott" (To God alone) for Decius's German of the *Gloria in excelsis* with the *Laudamus* (Sehling 11, p. 747; 13, p. 600). The Hildesheim editor dates it to Braunschweig in 1522. The text, the editor says, was first printed in Joachim Slüter's Rostock songbook of 1525, and the melody first in Valentin Schumann's Leipzig songbook of 1539. In Slüter's book of 1531 the hymn begins "Allene Godt yn der höge sy eer" (To God alone on high be glory; Sehling 7/2.1, p. 853, n. 11). The editors of the Westphalian volumes call Decius "Hovesch" (Sehling 21, p. 352, n. 7; 22, p. 566, n. 5). Fifty-nine orders name the hymn, in Low German and in High, from the Lippe Mass of about 1525–1538 into the seventeenth century. They are listed by use in §8.7.6. The Low German text is printed whole in the Lippe Mass (§8.7.3), and again at Neuenrade in 1564 (§8.7.4).

The Gloria in the order of the Mass is treated in Chapter 2, §2.7.

8.7.1 The German hymn inside the Latin Gloria

The Bugenhagen orders of Wolfenbüttel (1543) and Hildesheim (1544) interpolate the whole of "Allein Gott" (To God alone) into the Latin Gloria. The priest intones. The school choir sings the first line of the Latin. The whole church sings "Allein Gott" through. Then the scholars and the organ go on with *Laudamus te* (We praise thee) to the end. **Wolfenbüttel, *Kirchenordnung*, 1543** (Sehling 6/1, p. 55):

After the Kyrie the priest singeth: *Gloria in excelsis Deo* (Glory to God in the highest). The scholars' choir answereth and singeth: *Et in terra pax, hominibus bona voluntas* (And on earth peace, to men of good will), no more. Straightway the whole church singeth "To God alone on high be glory," etc., fully through. Thereafter the scholars and the organs sing on: *Laudamus te, benedicimus te* (We praise thee, we bless thee), etc., fully through.

The Hildesheim city order of 1544 has the same rubric almost word for word (Sehling 7/2.1, p. 852). So has the Schleswig-Holstein order of 1542, for Sundays and feasts, with "Allene Godt yn der höge sy eer" (To God alone on high be glory) sung "without break to the end, without organ-playing" (Sehling 23, p. 146; §9.3). The Osnabrück city order puts "Allein Gott" straight after the intonation, and then the Latin Gloria "to the end". **Osnabrück (city), *Kirchenordnung*, 1543** (Sehling 7/1, p. 258):

Gloria in excelsis; thereupon is sung "To God alone on high be glory"; thereafter the Latin *Gloria in excelsis*, followed through to the end.

8.7.2 Latin one Sunday, German the next

Where a school sang the Latin, many orders alternated it with the German hymn so that the people would not lose their part. The Prussian order says so outright. **Prussia, *Kirchenordnung und Ceremonien*, 1568** (Sehling 4, p. 81):

Thereupon the priest singeth with due reverence *Gloria in excelsis Deo* (Glory to God in the highest); the choir, one Sunday after the other, *Et in terra pax* (And on earth peace), or "To God alone on high be glory." For the German psalms must also be kept in use, and room be given to the common multitude also, that they may exercise their devotion with such spiritual songs.

Lüneburg, *Reformatio coenobiorum*, 1555, for the convents (Sehling 6/1, p. 614):

In the Mass shall be sung the introit, Kyrie eleison, *Gloria in excelsis et in terra pax* (Glory in the highest and on earth peace), or "To God alone on high," one Sunday after the other.

At Harzgerode in Anhalt the Latin *Gloria* and *Et in terra dominicale* (the Sunday Et in terra) alternated with the German on ordinary Sundays. At Christmas the old verses *Dies est laetitiae* (It is a day of gladness) were sung into it in Latin and German. **Harzgerode, *Kirchenordnunge*, 1534 (?)** (Sehling 2, p. 586):

Following, the Kyrie eleison on the great feasts, with the *Gloria in excelsis* and *Et in terra* (And on earth), upon the organ and by the choir; and at Christmas one may, after old custom, sing in among them the verses *Dies est laetitiae* with those following, in Latin and German. But on the common Sundays one shall sing by turns, one Sunday the Latin *Gloria* and the *Et in terra dominicale*, the other [the German] […].

Pomerania allowed the laity "Allein Gott" (To God alone) after the choir's *Et in terra*. When that grew too long, one or other was dropped by turns, and in Lent the Gloria might be left out altogether. **Pomerania, *Kirchenordnung*, 1542** (Sehling 4, p. 356):

The choir singeth thereupon the *Et in terra*; when that is out, let the laity sing "To God alone on high be glory." When it will grow too long, let the Latin be left off at times, and the German at times; in Lent the Gloria may well be left out altogether.

The Pomeranian *Agenda* of 1569 offers both German Glorias. **Pomerania, *Agenda*, 1569** (Sehling 4, p. 437):

Et in terra pax, in Latin or German: "To God alone on high be glory," etc., "All honour and praise shall be God's," etc.

8.7.3 Teaching the people to sing it

Oldenburg placed the sexton and some scholars among the congregation, below the choir. There they sang the German *Et in terra* (And on earth) and other German hymns in alternation with the upper choir, so that the people might learn tune and words. **Oldenburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1573** (Sehling 7/2.1, p. 1089):

[the scholars shall sing the *Et in terra pax* (And on earth peace), at times] in Latin by themselves, at times in German with the people, or else by turns. For which it is needful that the sexton or clerk, with some scholars, stand at a set place by the congregation beneath the choir, and sing the German *Et in terra*, as also other German spiritual songs, changing verses and stanzas with the upper choir, that the people may more and more grow used to the song, the melody and the words, and win pleasure and love thereto.

The Brenz order for Schwäbisch Hall had hoped for this from the start. **Schwäbisch Hall, *Kirchenordnung*, 1527** (Sehling 17/1, p. 49):

After the Kyrie eleison the song of praise to God, *Gloria in excelsis*, serveth well, according to the occasion of the season and the old custom. It were also good for the edifying of the church, as all things should be done in the common assembly, that the people should in time learn to sing in German the song of praise sung by the angels, *et in terra pax hominibus* (and on earth peace to men), and psalms.

Bugenhagen asked for "fine short German notes" for a German Gloria, so that children, maids and women could sing it together. **Braunschweig, *Kirchenordnung*, 1528** (Sehling 6/1, pp. 438–439):

But if one will at times sing the *Gloria in excelsis* in German, especially where there are no scholars, let fine short German notes also be provided for it, that children, maids and wives […] may sing along seemly and with one accord, and not only those that are used to the Latin singing.

An early Low German Mass from Lippe prints "Allene Gade in der hoge" (To God alone on high) as the Gloria then "commonly" sung, all four stanzas, after a prose German Gloria. **Lippe, *Deutsche Messe* [c. 1525–1538]** (Sehling 22, p. 566):

Commonly this Gloria in excelsis written hereafter is now sung […]. *Gloria in excelsis Deo* (Glory to God in the highest):

To God alone on high be glory, and thanks for his grace; for that now and nevermore can any harm touch us. God hath a good pleasure in us; now is great peace without ceasing; all strife hath now an end.

We laud, praise and worship thee; for thy glory we give thanks, that thou, God the Father, reignest everlastingly without any wavering. Wholly without measure is thy might; forthwith is done what thy will hath purposed. Well is us of so fine a Lord!

O Jesu Christ, only-begotten Son of thy heavenly Father, reconciler of them that were lost, thou stiller of our strife: Lamb of God, holy Lord and God, receive the prayer of our need, have mercy upon us. Amen.

O Holy Ghost, thou greatest good, thou most healing Comforter of all, keep henceforth from the devil's power them whom Jesus Christ redeemed through great torment and bitter death. Turn away all our misery and need; thereto we trust ourselves.

Neuenrade prints the same four stanzas in 1564, with "have mercy upon us poor ones" for Lippe's "have mercy upon us, amen" (Sehling 22, p. 528).

8.7.4 Intonation and answer

In Wittgenstein the priest intoned in German and the people answered with Decius's hymn. **Wittgenstein, *Kirchenordnung*, 1563** (Sehling 22, p. 102):

"Praise be to God on high." The choir or the people answereth: "To God alone on high be glory and thanks for his grace," etc.

At Ritzebüttel the people took up the priest's Low German intonation and sang it to the end. **Ritzebüttel, *Kirchenordnung*, 1556** (Sehling 5, p. 557):

Hereafter the priest singeth: "Glory be to God on high"; the people sing on and finish it: "To God alone on high be glory, and thanks for his grace," etc.

Neuenrade gave the choir three German answers to the priest. **Neuenrade, *Kirchenordnung*, 1564** (Sehling 22, p. 518):

The priest: "Glory be to God on high." The choir: "His wrath on earth," etc., or "And peace on earth," or "To God alone on high be glory," as all this is set down below with its notes.

The three are printed further on (Sehling 22, pp. 527–528):

- a rhymed *Et in terra* (And on earth) that begins "Sin torn up erden hebb ein end, / Sin fred und gnad sick tho uns wend" (His wrath on earth hath an end, his peace and grace turn unto us), whose lines agree with those of "All Ehr und Lob" (All honour and praise shall be God’s);
- a German Gloria in prose;
- Decius's hymn in all four stanzas, headed "another".

Luther's "All Ehr und Lob" was the other answer. In Nördlingen two choirs sang it stanza by stanza until the organ was ready. **Nördlingen, *Kirchenordnung* of Kaspar Löner, 1544** (Sehling 12, p. 312):

and the two choirs, until the organ might be made ready, [shall] sing the *Et in terra* also in German, as Doctor Martin Luther hath set it to the notes, one stanza after the other.

Naumburg, *Kirchen-Ordnung* for St Wenzel, 1537/1538 (Sehling 2, p. 78), for feast days:

Thereupon the priest singeth the *Gloria in excelsis* in German, as followeth: "Glory be to God on high." The antiphon of the angels: "All honour and praise shall be God's; he is, and is called, the Highest alone."

Hof also marks "All Ehr und Lob" as sung "in place of the Et in terra" at Pentecost (§8.6.4) and at Christmas, Epiphany and the Purification.

8.7.5 Left out: Advent, Lent, winter

The Gloria was the ordinary most easily dropped. Nördlingen left it out in Advent because the hymns after the epistle were long. **Nördlingen, *Ordnung der ceremonien* at St George's, 1555** (Sehling 12, p. 319):

But through Advent the *Gloria in excelsis* together with the *Et in terra* (And on earth) is left out, by reason of the long songs after the epistle.

At Meiningen it was left out in winter, "when it will grow too long". **Meiningen, *Gottesdienst-Ordnungen*, 1562/1566** (Sehling 2, p. 340):

[he] beginneth the office with the *Veni sancte Spiritus* (Come, Holy Spirit) in German; thereupon is sung a psalm, the Kyrie eleison in German, thereupon the Gloria (which is left out in winter, when it will grow too long), and the German *Et in terra*, "To God alone on high be glory," etc.

Where the Gloria was dropped, the German hymn went with it: in Advent at Nördlingen, in Lent in Pomerania (§8.7.2), and in winter at Meiningen. Elsewhere the Gloria kept its place in Advent, with a melody of its own. Pfalz-Zweibrücken lists among the

Latin chants of its choir "Kyrie in the Advent of the Lord. Glory to God in the highest" (Sehling 18, p. 255). The Oldenburg editor points to the Gloria that Lossius's *Psalmodia* sets with the Advent Kyrie (Sehling 7/2.1, p. 1088, n. 9). No order names a season for "Allein Gott" (To God alone) itself.

8.7.6 How fixed the Gloria was

The Gloria slot was **fixed**. When a hymn was sung, it was nearly always "Allein Gott in der Höh" (To God alone on high be glory), with "All Ehr und Lob" (All honour and praise shall be God's) as the alternative. The variation was not in which hymn was sung. It was in whether the German hymn replaced the Latin, alternated with it Sunday by Sunday, was inserted into it, or was left out for length or season.

The orders that name "Allein Gott". Fifty-two orders name it in the Gloria slot, and seven more name it only elsewhere. LG marks the Low German text. Each order is listed once, under its chief use, with the volume and page in Sehling.

How "Allein Gott" (To God alone) is sung	Orders
Inside the Latin Gloria, between *Et in terra pax* (And on earth peace) and *Laudamus te* (We praise thee)	Schleswig-Holstein 1542, LG (23, p. 146); Wolfenbüttel 1543, LG (6/1, p. 55); Hildesheim 1544, LG (7/2.1, p. 852)
With the Latin Gloria kept as well	Lippe [1542], LG, "Latin and German" (21, p. 352); Osnabrück (city) 1543, LG, then the Latin "to the end" (7/1, p. 258); Pomerania 1542, LG, after the choir's *Et in terra* (And on earth; 4, p. 356); Cochstedt 1556, after the Latin *Et in terra pax* (2, p. 484); Lüneburg 1575, on its day of deliverance (6/1, p. 663)
For the *Et in terra*, after the intonation	Lippe [c. 1525–1538], LG (22, p. 566); Hadeln 1526, LG (5, p. 468); Ostfriesland 1535, LG, as the Kyrie and Gloria in one (7/1, p. 376; §8.6.5); Osnabrück (Stift) 1543, LG (7/1, p. 224); Bergedorf 1544, LG (5, p. 387); Mecklenburg 1545, LG (5, p. 151); Stralsund 1555, LG (4, p. 551); Ritzebüttel 1556, LG (5, p. 557); Waldeck 1556 (9, p. 247); Pfalz-Zweibrücken 1557 (18, p. 188); Danzig 1557, in Sehling's summary (4, p. 168); Steuerwald and Peine 1561 (7/2.1, p. 781); Wittgenstein 1563 (22, p. 102); Neuenrade 1564, LG, one of three answers (22, p. 518); Thüngen 1564, or another psalm (11, p. 735); the Henneberg parishes of Belrieth and Einhausen, Goldlauter, Meiningen, Niederlauer, Obermaßfeld, and Sulzfeld and Klein-Bardorf, 1566 (2, pp. 329, 332, 340, 341, 343, 352); Aschersleben 1575, on the apostles' days (2, p. 480); Schweinfurt 1576 (11, p. 646); Hoya 1581 (6/2, p. 1148); Sensburg 1581 (4, p. 151); Grubenhagen 1583 (6/2, p. 1104); Soest 1609, at the middle sermons (22, p. 488); Osnabrück 1618 (7/1, p. 268); Stade c. 1620/22 (7/1, p. 56); Bischofswerda, in a letter of 1676, after a Kyrie in chant (2, p. 106)
Either it or the Latin *Et in terra*	Calenberg-Göttingen 1542, "in the stead of the Et in terra" (6/2, p. 793); Mecklenburg 1552, in the towns (5, p. 198); Amberg 1555/1557 (13, p. 290); Rostock c. 1560 (5, p. 288); Pomerania 1569, LG, or "All Ehr und Lob" (4, p. 437); Kurland 1570 (5, p. 88); Lippe 1571, in the towns (21, p. 387); the Mecklenburg convents 1572 (5, p. 256)
One Sunday the Latin, the next the German	the Lüneburg convents 1555 (6/1, p. 614); Prussia 1568 (4, p. 81)
In the villages	Lüneburg 1564 (6/1, p. 553); Braunschweig-Wolfenbüttel 1569 (6/1, p. 155); Oldenburg 1573 (7/2.1, p. 1112); Verden 1606 (7/1, p. 164). Several of the orders above give it to their villages too: Pomerania 1542 (4, p. 358), Mecklenburg 1552 (5, p. 202), Pfalz-Zweibrücken 1557 (18, p. 212), Prussia 1568 (4, p. 83), Pomerania 1569 (4, p. 440) and Lippe 1571 (21, p. 396)

Outside the Gloria. The hymn was also sung:

- in a service without communion, as one of the German psalms before the collect: Mecklenburg 1552 (5, p. 199), Amberg 1555/1557 (13, p. 292), Pfalz-Zweibrücken 1557 (18, p. 209) and Verden 1606 (7/1, p. 162). Lippe [1542] calls it "the psalm *To God alone on high*" (21, p. 352);
- between the epistle and the gospel: Sayn 1590 (19/1, p. 412);
- after the sermon: at Northeim 1539, while the preacher came down and made ready the hosts and the cup (6/2, p. 926); at Osnabrück 1543, after the holy-day catechism sermon for the servants (7/1, p. 250); and at Lüneburg 1575, before and after the sermon on its day of deliverance (6/1, pp. 662–663);
- at Christmas, to close the middle sermon of the first day with thanks for the incarnation: Tangermünde 1603 (3, p. 339);
- after a baptism, or "Sei Lob und Ehr" (Praise and honour be to the highest good): Berlin 1574 (3, p. 167), Salzwedel 1579, Old Town and New Town (3, pp. 276, 291), and Perleberg 1581 (3, p. 256);
- to close a confirmation, or "Es woll uns Gott genädig sein" (May God be gracious to us): Pomerania 1569 (4, p. 445).

Kurland put it sixth, as "the Gloria", in the list of hymns that the pastors of the non-German country people were to teach them, after the five chief parts of the catechism: "6. The Gloria: To God alone on high be glory" (Sehling 5, p. 91).

8.8 Between the epistle and the gospel

This is the slot of the gradual, alleluia, tract and sequence. It is the one where German hymns were first put into the Mass (Luther, *Formula missae* [Form of the Mass]: "after the graduals"), and it is by far the most variable. Here the orders let the hymn change with the season, the feast and sometimes the gospel of the Sunday. Most per-Sunday hymn tables in the corpus are tables for this slot. This is the slot that later came to be called the *Hauptlied* or *Graduallied*, though neither word occurs in the corpus (see the Introduction, The hymn database).

8.8.1 The rule: a pure sequence, or a German psalm

The standard formula names the sequence first and "a German psalm" as the alternative. The choice depends on the school, the season, the length of the service, and whether the sequence is "pure". **Saxony (Albertine), *Kirchenordnung*, 1539** (Sehling 1, p. 271):

thereupon the epistle in German toward the people; thereafter a sequence, or a German psalm, or another spiritual song, as every season requireth.

Kurpfalz, provisional *Kirchenordnung*, 1546 (Sehling 14, p. 96):

then let the choir sing the alleluia with a sequence that is pure and not contrary to holy Scripture. Where such is not at hand, let the sequence be left off; or a tract may be sung, as this: *Domine, non secundum peccata nostra facias nobis* (O Lord, deal not with us after our sins), etc.

The later northern orders name the reason for having both. The Latin trains the scholars and the German lets the congregation sing. **Wolfenbüttel, *Kirchenordnung*, 1569** (Sehling 6/1, p. 143):

After the epistle a sequence or alleluia or tract is sung, such as are pure, that the scholars also may be exercised in the Latin song; or out of Doctor Luther's songbook a German psalm, that the Christian congregation may sing along and also have its godly exercise.

This sentence comes from the Lüneburg order of 1564 and passed into Oldenburg (1573). The Northeim order insists the choice is free. **Northeim, *Kirchenordnung*, 1539** (Sehling 6/2, p. 925):

After the epistle the choir may also sing the alleluia and sequence, when the text is pure and the time not too short; or else, in the stead of the alleluia and sequence, a psalm with the whole congregation. For such things must be free and subject to no law.

Honterus's reformation of Kronstadt in Transylvania uses the same test: German songs, or the customary chants, "if they be not repugnant to Scripture". **Kronstadt, Honterus, *Reformationsbüchlein*, 1543**, Latin text (Sehling 24, p. 183):

We use the customary songs of the season, and in those things which the primitive church kept we change nothing; save that after the epistle we sometimes use German songs, and sometimes other customary ones, if they be not repugnant to the Scriptures.

8.8.2 The sequences cut back to the chief feasts

Most of the medieval sequences were dropped. The northern orders keep only three, for the three high feasts of Christ, and always "with its German song". **Schleswig-Holstein, *Kirchenordnung*, 1542** (Sehling 23, p. 90):

thereafter, for the gradual, a German psalm taken out of Scripture, or else a gradual that hath two verses. The sequences and prosae shall all be left off and not sung, save on the three great feasts of Christ: as from Christmas unto Candlemas, *Grates nunc omnes* (Let us all now give thanks), with its German song.

The Wolfenbüttel order of 1543 and the Hildesheim city order of 1544 carry the same rule, naming the three German songs: "Gelobet seist du" (Praised be thou, Jesus Christ) with *Grates nunc omnes*, "Christ lag in Todesbanden" (Christ lay in death's bonds) with *Victimae paschali*, and "Nun bitten wir" (Now pray we) with *Veni sancte Spiritus* (Come, Holy Spirit).

Herford gives the reason: the old sequences were godless, and God will be honoured only according to his word. **Herford, *Kirchenordnung*, 1532** (Sehling 21, pp. 176–177):

In former times godless sequences were sung in the Mass without any discretion. Such we will no more keep, since we now know by God's grace that God will be honoured according to his word, and all service of God is worth nothing that is not done according to his word (Matthew 15). So from Christmas unto Easter we will sing the sequence *Grates nunc*, etc., and between, "Praised be thou, Jesu Christ," and "Thanks say we all," etc., two verses each time, and at the last *Huic oportet*, etc.

From Easter unto Pentecost shall be sung the sequence *Victimae paschali*, etc., thereupon "Christ lay in the bands of death," or "Christ is arisen," etc. But at Pentecost shall be sung the sequence *Veni sancte Spiritus*, etc., and thereupon, after every two verses, "Now pray we the Holy Ghost." On the day of the Holy Trinity, the introit *Benedicta* (Blessed be) and the sequence *Benedicta sit sancta*, thereupon "Now pray we the Holy Ghost," if one will. Yet little shall be sung of long sequences.

Wittenberg (1533) is more generous, but it names one sequence it will not have: the "lousy and monkish" sequence of St John the Baptist. **Wittenberg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1533** (Sehling 1, p. 704):

On the Nativity of John, the sequence *Psallite regi nostro* (Sing ye to our King), etc. For the lousy and monkish sequence *Sancti Johannis Christi praeconis* (Of Saint John, the herald of Christ), etc., and the like, we will not have. The sequence of Mary Magdalene, *Laus tibi Christe* (Praise to thee, O Christ), may be sung once or twice in the year upon a Sunday, when one will. But the sequence of the Holy Trinity as oft as one will.

The Brandenburg-Ansbach *Auctuarium*, an Interim order, lists the "pure and good" sequences of the chief feasts. On other days it puts a German psalm-hymn in the place of an impure gradual or alleluia. For the Purification its "sequence" is already Luther's German "Mit Fried und Freud" (With peace and joy I depart). **Brandenburg-Ansbach, *Auctuarium*, 1548** (Interim order; Sehling 11, p. 329):

The chiefest feasts have their pure and good sequences. By these one shall abide, namely: the Nativity of the Lord, *Grates nunc omnes reddamus Domino* (Let us all now render thanks to the Lord); the Purification, "In peace and joy I now depart"; Easter, *Victimae paschali laudes* (Praises to the paschal victim); of the Trinity, *Benedicta semper sancta sit Trinitas* (Blessed be the holy Trinity for ever); of the Holy Ghost, *Veni, Sancte Spiritus*, or *Sancti Spiritus adsit nobis gratia* (May the grace of the Holy Spirit be with us). On the other holy days and feasts, that have no pure sequences or none, the gradual or alleluia shall be sung. But where these were not pure, as commonly of the saints, let one of these psalms be sung in their stead: "A mighty fortress is our God," etc.; "Were God not with us at this time," etc.; "Blessed is he that standeth in God's fear," etc.; "Out of the depths," etc.; "Man, wilt thou live blessedly," etc. Then also on Sundays the graduals and alleluias may be changed about, and one of the said psalms sung in their stead, for the people's sake.

8.8.3 Farced sequences: Latin verses and German stanzas by turns

At the three high feasts the northern and Saxon orders sang the Latin sequence with the stanzas of a German *Leise* (Leise (a vernacular hymn ending Kyrieleis)) sung between its verses, by the people or the whole church. The pairs are always the same:

Season	Latin sequence	German hymn sung between
Christmas to Candlemas	*Grates nunc omnes* (Let us all now give thanks)	"Gelobet seist du, Jesu Christ" (Praised be thou, Jesus Christ; at Herford also "Dank sagen wir alle" [Let us all give thanks to God])

Season	Latin sequence	German hymn sung between
Easter to Ascension or Pentecost	*Victimae paschali*	"Christ lag in Todesbanden" (Christ lay in death's bonds) or "Christ ist erstanden" (Christ is arisen)
Pentecost	*Veni sancte Spiritus* (Come, Holy Spirit)	"Nun bitten wir den heiligen Geist" (Now pray we the Holy Ghost)
Trinity (some orders)	*Benedicta semper sit Trinitas* (Blessed be the Trinity for ever)	"Nun bitten wir" (Now pray we; Herford) or "Gott der Vater wohn uns bei" (God the Father, dwell with us; Anhalt)

The Hamburg order of 1529 gives the scheme exactly. *Grates* is sung three times, each time followed by two German stanzas. *Huic oportet* is followed by the last stanza. At Easter a stanza of "Christ lag" comes after every verse of *Victimae*. At Pentecost a German stanza of "Nun bitten" (Now pray we the Holy Ghost) comes after every two Latin verses of *Veni sancte*. **Hamburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1529** (Sehling 5, p. 530):

From Christmas unto the Purification shall be sung the sequence *Grates nunc omnes*, etc., and after this manner, between, the song "Praised be thou, Jesu Christ," etc. First *Grates* shall be sung, thereupon two German verses; once more *Grates* and two other German verses; also the third time *Grates* and two other German verses. At the last *Huic oportet*, with the last German verse. From Easter unto Pentecost shall be sung the sequence *Victimae paschali*, so that after every verse one also sing a verse of the German song "Christ lay in the bands of death." But the song "Christ is arisen" shall be sung after the accustomed manner when the sermon is begun. At Pentecost shall be sung the sequence *Veni sancte Spiritus*, and after every two Latin verses a German verse of the song "Now pray we the Holy Ghost," etc.

The Prussian order of 1568 has the same scheme and adds Trinity. The Trinity sequence is to alternate Sunday by Sunday with a German psalm, "that the German songs may remain in the church". **Prussia, *Kirchenordnung und Ceremonien*, 1568** (Sehling 4, p. 81):

After the epistle, on the feast days, the sequences are sung where they are pure: as at Christmas, *Grates nunc omnes*; and when that hath been sung once, thereupon with the congregation the two first verses of "Praised be thou, Jesu Christ," etc.; when it is sung the second time, again two verses of the same psalm. When *Huic oportet, ut canamus cum angelis* (To him it is meet that we sing with the angels) hath then been sung, the three last verses shall follow; and this shall be kept from Christmas unto the Purification. At Easter the sequence *Victimae paschali laudes* (Praises to the paschal victim) is sung, and among it "Christ lay in the bands of death," verse by verse. At Pentecost is sung *Veni sancte Spiritus et emitte coelitus* (Come, Holy Spirit, and send from heaven), etc., and after two Latin verses always one German verse out of the fair song "Now pray we the Holy Ghost," etc. On Trinity the sequence *Benedicta semper sit Trinitas* is sung; and the same may be changed on the following Sundays, one after the other, with a German psalm, so that one Sunday the said sequence is sung, the other a German psalm, that the German songs may remain in the church.

In Mecklenburg the organ played the Latin verses and the cantor sang the German stanzas in between. The Latin text was not sung at all; the organ stood for it. **Mecklenburg, *Ordeninge der misse*, 1545** (Sehling 5, p. 152):

At Christmas and onward unto the Purification the sequence *Grates nunc omnes* shall be sung after this manner. Where there is an organ, let the organist play *Grates*. Thereafter let him hold still, and the cantor begin "Praised be thou." Thereafter the other verse, "Of the eternal Father," and then sing *Grates nunc omnes*. Thereafter the organist playeth *Grates* again. […] At Easter likewise: let the organist play *Victimae*; let the cantor begin the two first verses of "Christ lay in the bands of death."

The same Mecklenburg order sang Luther's Advent hymn "Nun komm der Heiden Heiland" (Now come, Savior of the heathen; the German *Veni redemptor*) after the Advent alleluia.

The Calenberg order sets the German stanzas "between every verse". **Calenberg-Göttingen, *Kirchenordnung*, 1542** (Sehling 6/2, p. 793):

Touching the sequence, one shall sing the same also after the alleluia; yet so that from Easter unto Pentecost one sing *Victimae paschali*; from Pentecost unto Trinity, *Veni, sancte Spiritus*; from Trinity, as long as it seemeth good to the pastor, the sequence of the Holy Trinity; from Christmas unto the Purification of Mary, *Grates nunc omnes*. But here, between every verse, one shall sing the customary German songs: at Easter, "Christ is arisen"; at Pentecost, "Now pray we the Holy Ghost"; at Christmas, "Praised be thou, Jesu Christ," etc.

At Harzgerode the people "sang in" the German stanzas, and on ordinary Sundays a German song took the place of the sequence. On the feasts of Our Lady the hymn was "Herr Christ, der einig Gotts Sohn" (Lord Christ, the only Son of God). **Harzgerode, *Kirchenordnunge*, 1534 (?)** (Sehling 2, p. 586):

At Christmas, in the sequence *Grates nunc omnes*, the German stanzas "Praised be thou" with those following are sung in among it by the people; at Easter the sequence *Victimae paschali* together with "Christ is arisen"; at Pentecost the sequence *Veni sancte Spiritus et emitte coelitus*, and thereto the stanzas "Now pray we the Holy Ghost" with the others; on the common Sundays, in the stead of the sequence, a German song or psalm; on the feasts of Our Lady the song "Lord Christ, the only Son of God."

The Anhalt *Ordnung der deutschen Gesänge* (Order of the German songs) calls this "weaving in". **Anhalt, *Ordnung der deutschen Gesänge*, before 8 February 1551** (Sehling 2, p. 555):

On the high feast days, as Christmas, Easter, Pentecost and Trinity, one may sing the Mass and vespers in Latin and in descant. Yet so that the German songs belonging to the feast days be woven in among the sequences before the gospel, and that there and everywhere else, before the sermon on the gospel, the creed be sung in German.

In the Hadersleben articles of 1528 the Latin sequences of the great feasts are allowed "and the *Leisen* in them". **Hadersleben, *Artikel*, 1528** (Sehling 23, p. 64):

It shall also be free for them on the great feasts to sing the *Gloria in excelsis* in Latin, likewise the alleluia and a sequence, as *Grates nunc omnes*, *Victimae paschali*, *Veni Sancte Spiritus* (Come, Holy Spirit), and the *Leisen* therein; item the Latin *Patrem* (the Nicene Creed), prefaces, *Sanctus* and *Agnus Dei* (Lamb of God); yet only on the great feasts.

8.8.4 German sequences

Some orders sang the sequence itself in German prose, to the Latin melody. The Calenberg printed Masses of 1542 give "Danksagen wir alle Gott" (Let us all give thanks to God) as the Christmas sequence (the German *Grates*), followed by "Gelobet seist du" (Praised be thou, Jesus Christ). **Calenberg-Göttingen, *Kirchenordnung*, 1542**, the German Christmas Mass (Sehling 6/2, p. 820):

Sequence. [Notes:] "Thanks say we all to God, our Lord Christ, who hath enlightened us with his word, hath redeemed us with his blood from the power of the devil. Him shall we all praise with his angels, with sound, singing: Praise be to God on high" [end of notes]. A song of praise of the birth of Christ.

The same Calenberg Masses have the Easter sequence "Laßt uns Christen alle singen" (Let us Christians all sing) with "Christ ist erstanden" (Christ is arisen) sung between its verses. The Pentecost sequence is "Komm, du Tröster, heiliger Geist" (Come, thou Comforter, Holy Ghost) with "Nun bitten wir" (Now pray we) "between every verse". The Hessian *Agende* of 1574 (Philippist) printed the same German sequences in its songbook appendix (Sehling 8, pp. 464–469). At Hof the Easter sequence was sung in German as "Wir Christen opfern allesamt" (We Christians all offer). **Hof, *Ordo ecclesiasticus*, 1592** (Sehling 11, p. 440):

After the epistle: "Christ lay in the bands of death," or the sequence *Victimae paschali* in German, "We Christians offer all together."

8.8.5 A hymn in the place of the gradual

Calenberg's German Masses replace the gradual and alleluia outright on two days. At the Purification the hymn is Simeon's song in Luther's version (Sehling 6/2, p. 823):

For the gradual and alleluia let the song of Simeon be sung, as followeth. [Notes:] "In peace and joy I now depart, according to God's will."

In the Passion Mass Psalm 51 replaces the sequence (Sehling 6/2, p. 825):

In the stead of the sequence let the following psalm be sung: "Have mercy on me, O Lord God, after thy great mercy!"

8.8.6 A German psalm that "rhymes with the gospel"

The fullest rule for choosing the hymn is in Pomerania (1542) and Mecklenburg (1545). On ordinary Sundays the German psalm-hymn is to be chosen by the matter of the Sunday gospel. Faith and grace, Christ's enemies, good works and the right use of

earthly goods each have their hymns. **Pomerania, *Kirchenordnung*, 1542** (Sehling 4, p. 356):

or on the other Sundays a psalm that rhymeth with the gospel as much as may be: as, when the gospel speaketh of faith and of grace, let "Salvation now is come to us" be sung, item "Through Adam's fall," or the like; but when the gospel speaketh of the godless Jews and hypocrites, how they deal against Christ, let "The mouth of the unwise saith indeed" be sung, item "Ah God, from heaven"; when it speaketh of good works which God commandeth us, let "Lord, who shall dwell," etc. be sung; and other psalms which one knoweth to use most fitly.

Mecklenburg, *Ordeninge der misse*, 1545 (Sehling 5, p. 153):

In the villages a German psalm shall always be sung, as may also at times be done in the towns; and especially the psalms that rhyme with the holy gospel. As, when the gospel speaketh of faith and of grace, let "Salvation now is come to us," etc., "Through Adam's fall," be sung. If it be a teaching of our Saviour, let "God's justice and wondrous deed" be sung. If the gospel speak of the Jews, how they deal against Christ, let "The mouth of the unwise saith indeed," "Ah God, from heaven look down," "Where God the Lord standeth not by us," and the second psalm, "Help, God, how goeth it ever so," be sung. When it speaketh of good works, let "These are the holy ten commandments," "Blessed is he that standeth in God's fear," "Lord, who shall dwell in thy tabernacle" […] be sung. When the gospel is a teaching of the right use of these transitory things, let "Except God himself build the house" be sung.

Later orders keep the rule in shorter form. **Pomerania, *Agenda*, 1569** (Sehling 4, p. 438):

Hereupon the choir singeth the sequence of the season or of the feast, or the tract, or at times an alleluia with the gradual, or on the Sundays a German psalm that rhymeth with the gospel. On the Sundays after Trinity the sequence of the Trinity shall be sung every month. When apostles' days, the Beheading of John, Mary Magdalene, the Conversion of Paul, the holy martyrs fall, the same sequence shall be sung on the Sunday before or after, as it falleth, as Lossius hath set them; that the old glorious songs of the apostles, evangelists, etc. be not wholly lost.

Naumburg, *Kirchen-Ordnung* for St Wenzel, 1537/1538 (Sehling 2, p. 71):

A German psalm according to the occasion of the season, or one that rhymeth with the gospel.

Weissenfels, *Ordnung der geseng*, 1578 (Sehling 1, p. 693). This is the order whose one-hymn-per-Sunday table is printed in `hymns.db`:

The congregation singeth a German song that fitteth the season and the gospel; as on the first Sunday of Advent, "Now come, the Saviour of the heathen."

At Weissenfels even the festal Mass sung in figured music kept this German hymn. **Weissenfels, *Ordnung der geseng*, 1578** (Sehling 1, p. 694):

On the feasts the aforenamed songs are all sung in figured music, save the German songs after the epistle in the Mass and after the hymn in the vespers.

Verden, *Kirchenordnung*, 1606 (Sehling 7/1, p. 156):

After the epistle one shall sing a sequence or alleluia of the season, or a German psalm that agreeth with the text or content of the gospel.

8.8.7 Sunday and season tables for this slot

Many orders fix the hymn for this slot by season, and some by Sunday. The tables of Pomerania (1569), Pfalz-Zweibrücken (1565), Weissenfels (1578), Mansfeld (1580) and Hohenlohe (1596) are extracted in `hymns.db` and described in the Introduction (The hymn database). They are not repeated here, but Appendix 8.A sets out the hymn that they and the old hymnals most often give to each Sunday and feast. The following orders have tables that are not in `hymns.db`.

Neuenrade, *Kirchenordnung*, 1564, Low German (Sehling 22, pp. 530–531). The table runs by season. Holy Week has no hymn in this slot; instead, a Passion hymn is split around the sermon. The order closes with an open clause for the rest of the year:

After the epistle the alleluia is sung, and the sequence, or else a song, as they are here ordained one after another. In Advent: alleluia; thereupon "Lord Christ, the only Son of God," etc. From Christmas unto the Purification: alleluia, *Grates nunc omnes* (Let

us all now give thanks) […]; thereupon "Praised be thou, Jesu Christ" […]. On the Purification or Candlemas, after the alleluia, "In peace and joy I now depart," etc. In Lent: "In the midst of life we are compassed with death," etc. On the Annunciation and the Visitation: "Lord Christ, the only Son of God, Father in eternity," etc.

From Easter unto the Ascension: alleluia; thereupon followeth *Victimae paschali laudes* (Praises to the paschal victim), etc., and the people sing between: "Christ is arisen"; or one singeth "Christ lay in the bands of death" […]. The Ascension: alleluia, "Now rejoice, dear Christians all," etc. […] Pentecost: alleluia, "Now pray we the Holy Ghost," etc. Trinity: "God the Father be with us," etc. Michaelmas: "Now praise, my soul, the Lord," etc. At other times one taketh what one will and what fitteth best.

Anhalt, *Ordnung der deutschen Gesänge*, before 8 February 1551 (Sehling 2, p. 556). This order gives hymns by season for three slots: before the early sermon, in the Mass before the gospel, and before the vesper sermon. For the Trinity season it tells the Mass to keep one hymn for about four Sundays running, so that the congregation may learn it:

After Trinity. Until Advent let "Now pray we the Holy [Ghost]" be sung always before the early sermon; but in the Mass these following songs shall be sung before the gospel, some four Sundays one after another, until Advent, that the congregation may the more easily learn and keep them: "Have mercy on me, O Lord God"; "Our Father in the kingdom of heaven"; "Salvation now is come to us" (about half, and the other half afterward); "Ah God, from heaven look down"; "The mouth of the unwise saith indeed"; "A mighty fortress"; "May God be gracious unto us"; "Out of the depths"; "I call to thee, Lord Jesu Christ"; and the like.

Prussia, *Kirchenordnung*, 1544 (Sehling 4, p. 65). Here the alleluia is sung "with the melody rhymed to" the German psalm that follows. The list is to be rotated, "as is the use at Königsberg":

There followeth the alleluia, with the melody rhymed to the German psalm that one will sing, as: "Joyfully will we sing alleluia"; "A mighty fortress is our God"; Doctor Martin's song of the baptism of Christ; item his "Our Father in the kingdom of heaven"; item "Ah Father of ours, who art," etc. To be changed about, as is the use at Königsberg, etc. On the feasts there is proper matter, as at Easter "Christ lay in the bands of death," item "Jesus Christ our Saviour"; at Pentecost, "Come, God Creator, Holy Ghost," "Now pray we the Holy Ghost"; at Christmas, "Praised be thou, Jesu Christ," item *Grates nunc omnes*, "Thanks say we now all," etc.

Nördlingen, *Ordnung der ceremonien* at St George's, 1555 (Sehling 12, p. 323). The order prints a Sunday list for the psalm after the epistle, taken from Naumburg. It then leaves the choice open:

According to the occasion of the time, as it standeth in Christendom, one may well take at times others in this place, that fit themselves more fitly to every season; likewise also when one singeth measured music.

The Nördlingen order of 1579 prints its own list and fits it to the sermon as well. **Nördlingen, *Kirchenordnung*, 1579** (Sehling 12, p. 386):

But where on the sixth of January, or the Sunday before Epiphany, it is preached of the baptism of Christ, the psalm "Christ our Lord to Jordan came," etc. shall be sung. From the Purification unto the Sunday Septuagesima, "In peace and joy I now depart," etc.

Pirna, *Kirchenordnung* of Anton Lauterbach, 1555 (Sehling 1, pp. 642–643). This order lists two German hymns for each Sunday. It says they are arranged by the sense of the Sunday epistles and gospels, and may give way to Latin on the high feasts:

These German songs are ordered according to the sense of the Sunday epistles and gospels, and may sometimes be changed for Latin songs for the exercise of the scholars in music, chiefly on the solemn feasts, when pure responsories, hymns, introits and graduals may be sung in the accustomed order.

The Mansfeld table of 1580 goes furthest toward gospel narrative hymns. For the first Sunday after Trinity, whose gospel is Dives and Lazarus, it adds a ballad of the rich man, marked * as not by Luther. **Mansfeld, *Kirchen-Agenda*, 1580** (Sehling 2, p. 238):

The first Sunday after Trinity: "God the Father be with us," etc.; "Ah God, from heaven look down," etc.; *"There was once a rich man."

On Oculi, Mansfeld puts the litany in the place of the sequence (Sehling 2, p. 238):

Here also the litany shall be sung, in the stead of the sequence, when the people are come together.

8.8.8 Why the hymn might not change: an unknown tune

Hof's Sunday table shows why a new hymn could not always be sung. For Septuagesima it offers a familiar alternative, because the congregation did not know the new hymn and "heareth only the tune". **Hof, *Ordo ecclesiasticus*, 1592** (Sehling 11, p. 436):

After the epistle: "Lord God, we call upon thy name," or instead "Ah God, from heaven look down," because the foregoing, as also the song of the coming Sunday, is unknown to the common man, and he heareth only the tune.

For Advent the same table offers a shorter hymn "when it is very cold", and keeps the longer one for the communion (Sehling 11, p. 432):

After the epistle: "Through Adam's fall is all corrupt," or, when it is very cold, "I call to thee, Lord Jesu"; so that the foregoing be kept back for the communion; or else the sequence "When the good God would fulfil."

Wittgenstein rotated its psalm-hymns for the opposite reason: so that the congregation would not stay "on one side" and leave the other fine psalms unlearned. **Wittgenstein, *Kirchenordnung*, 1563** (Sehling 22, p. 103):

This order is kept some Sundays after the high feasts. But when that time is out, in the stead of the foregoing songs other spiritual German psalms shall be sung, so that nevertheless this order and the whole action remain and be kept in its being continually. And the pastors in the villages shall exhort and instruct their little folk to learn to sing along such psalms, as these are: "Through Adam's fall," etc.; "These are the holy ten commandments," etc.; "I call upon thee, Lord Jesu Christ," etc.; "Now rejoice, dear Christians all," etc.; "Out of the depths I cry to thee," etc.; "Have mercy on me, O Lord God," etc.; "A mighty fortress is our God," etc.; "Where God the Lord standeth not by us," etc.; "Ah God, from heaven look down," etc.; "The mouth of the unwise saith indeed," etc.; of which psalms one shall sing one after the other in turn, that one abide not always on one side and the fair psalms remain unlearned.

8.8.9 The litany in this slot

Several orders put a litany between the epistle and the gospel. Lüneburg used a Kyrie-litany hymn, "Nim von uns, Herr Gott" (Take from us, Lord God). It gave way when there were children to baptize, and baptism was then held between the epistle and the gospel. **Lüneburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1564** (Sehling 6/1, pp. 543–544):

After the epistle a sequence or alleluia is sung, "Praise ye the Lord," or "Take from us, Lord God, all our sin and misdeed," and the priest [prayeth] the prayer wherein the litany is comprised.

But when the time falleth too short, or there be children to baptize, then either the sequence or the song "Take from us, Lord God," etc., or the tract, one or all, may be left out. When, then, there be children to baptize, they shall be baptized before the lesson of the gospel. But when there be no children to baptize, or there is otherwise time enough, the litany shall always be sung.

Kurland, *Kirchenordnung*, 1570 (Sehling 5, p. 88), which prints the same hymn:

Following, the sequence of the season with the alleluia; or on the common Sundays a Christian psalm; at times the litany; or, for brevity's sake, this litany: "Take from us, dear Lord, our sin and misdeed."

Regensburg used the Prussian litany with "Erhalt uns, Herr" (Keep us, Lord, by thy word) as its appendix, and the sequence only when there was figured music. **Regensburg, *Kirchenordnung* of Justus Jonas, 1553** (Sehling 13, p. 420):

Thereafter the choir singeth the litany set forth in Prussia, with the appendix "Keep us, Lord, by thy word," etc. […] But on special feasts it is the custom now and then, for brevity's sake, as oft as figured music is sung, to take the alleluia and sequence of the season in the stead of the litany.

The later Regensburg order even calls "Erhalt uns" (Keep us) the "sequence of the season". **Regensburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1567** (Sehling 13, p. 462):

thereupon the choir singeth the sequence of the season: "Keep us, Lord, by thy word," or else something German.

The Litany as a rite, with its forms, singers and days, is treated in Chapter 13, §13.21.

8.8.10 How fixed the slot was

This slot was **variable**. At the three high feasts it was fixed by the farced sequence and its *Leise* (Leise (a vernacular hymn ending Kyrieleis)). Through the rest of the year practice ran along a scale:

1. A short list rotated to teach the people (Anhalt 1551, Prussia 1544, Wittgenstein 1563).
2. Seasonal assignment (Neuenrade 1564, Mansfeld, Nördlingen 1579).
3. A Sunday-by-Sunday table matched to the gospel (Pirna 1555, Weissenfels 1578, Hof 1592, Pomerania 1569).
4. The rule of Pomerania 1542 and Mecklenburg 1545, which chooses by the matter of the gospel without a fixed table.

The Latin alternatives (sequence, alleluia, tract) and the litany came in at the edges.

8.9 The creed: "Wir glauben all"

The creed slot is among the most fixed in the corpus. Luther's "Wir glauben all an einen Gott" (We all believe in one God) was sung by the people, either instead of the Latin *Patrem* (the Nicene Creed) or after it. It is named in more orders than any other hymn except "Nun bitten" (Now pray we the Holy Ghost) and the communion hymns. The alternatives are few:

- the Apostles' Creed sung "word for word" ("Ich glaub an Gott Vater", I believe in God the Father), a sung prose form;
- a German Nicene Creed;
- rarely, the Athanasian Creed in German;
- in Advent at Schweinfurt, "Wir glauben" (We believe) in the place of "Nun bitten" (§8.9.4).

What varies is where the creed stands and what it is used for.

The creed in the order of the Mass, Nicene or Apostles', is treated in Chapter 2, §2.9.

8.9.1 After the gospel, with or instead of the Latin *Patrem*

The *Deutsche Messe* (German Mass) set the pattern: "After the gospel the whole church singeth the creed in German: We all believe in one God" (§8.3.2). Where the Latin was kept, the people sang the German creed after it, or even at the same time as it. **Pfalz-Neuburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1543** (Sehling 13, p. 72):

After the gospel the priest shall sing the *Credo* and the choir the *Patrem* (the Nicene Creed) in Latin; or, where there is no choir, the priest may sing or say it himself, and meanwhile let the people sing the German song "We all believe in one God."

At Aschersleben the credal slot rotated over four Sundays: German, Latin with the *Patrem*, figured music, and the litany. **Aschersleben, *Kirchen-Agenda*, 1575** (Sehling 2, p. 478):

The cantor shall also sing one Sunday in German, the other in Latin (whereto the *Patrem* also belongeth), the third Sunday figured music, and the fourth sing the litany.

The Hessian *Agende* (Philippist) allows three German creeds, and on occasion the German *Grates nunc omnes* (Let us all now give thanks) in their place. **Hessen, *Agende*, 1574** (Philippist; Sehling 8, p. 411):

Upon the reading of the gospel the Apostles' Creed is sung in German, word for word; or as Doctor Luther hath set it in paraphrase after the manner of a song; or the Nicene Creed in German. One may also now and then, after the gospel, sing the German *Grates nunc omnes*, or another short song, and thereupon read the Nicene or the Athanasian Creed to the people before the altar with a clear voice.

At Brieg (1592) the Latin Nicene Creed alternated Sunday by Sunday with the Athanasian Creed in German, taken from Triller's songbook. **Brieg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1592** (Sehling 3, p. 446):

after the epistle a German song out of the songbook of Doctor Luther; after the gospel the Nicene or Athanasian Creed, one Sunday in Latin, the other Sunday the Athanasian Creed in German, out of Triller's songbook.

In the Prussian villages the creed-hymn is followed at once by "Nun bitten" (Now pray we the Holy Ghost), so the two together lead into the sermon. **Prussia, *Kirchenordnung und Ceremonien*, 1568** (Sehling 4, p. 83):

after the gospel is sung "We all believe in one God," etc., and after the same, "Now pray we the Holy Ghost," etc.

8.9.2 After the sermon: the creed as the offertory

In Bugenhagen's orders the sermon comes between the gospel and the creed. After it the people sing the creed while the communicants go into the choir and the priest prepares the bread and wine. The creed-hymn thus fills the slot of the old offertory. **Hamburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1529** (Sehling 5, p. 528):

When the preacher cometh down, the priest before the altar, turned toward the altar, singeth: "I believe in one God." Then the people or the choir sing the whole Nicene Creed through, verse by verse, and thereto "We all believe in one God," etc. Meanwhile the communicants go into the choir, the women and maidens on the left side apart, and the men and servants on the right side apart; and the priest prepareth bread and wine, and what is needful thereto.

In the Braunschweig order of 1528 the creed stood before the sermon, and a German psalm or song after the sermon did this work. **Braunschweig, *Kirchenordnung*, 1528** (Sehling 6/1, p. 441):

When the preacher cometh down, a German psalm or song is sung; meanwhile the communicants go into the choir, the women and maidens on the left side apart, and the men and servants on the right side apart; and the priest prepareth bread and wine, and what is needful thereto.

Buxtehude sings all three stanzas of "Wir glauben" (We believe) without the organ, because in it the church confesses its faith. **Buxtehude, *Kirchenordnung*, 1552** (Sehling 7/1, p. 75):

When the sermon is ended, the preacher in the pulpit shall begin "We believe" for the choir and people. And because in "We believe" the church confesseth her faith, all three verses shall be sung wholly through by the congregation without organ. While "We believe" is being sung, the communicants shall go into the choir, seemly, orderly, with reverence, there to receive the most worthy sacrament.

Bremen, *Kirchenordnung*, 1534 (Sehling 7/2.2, p. 460):

Thereafter the sexton or schoolmaster, with his disciples and all the people, men and women, who are exhorted to sing, singeth the creed. And during it the communicants go into the choir.

Osnabrück (Stift), *Kirchenordnung*, 1543 (Sehling 7/1, p. 224):

After the sermon the priest before the altar beginneth *Credo in unum Deum* (I believe in one God). Thereupon is sung "We all believe in one God," etc.

The Lüneburg city order of 1575 keeps the organ silent during the creed. The creed also covers the minister's return to the altar. **Lüneburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1575** (Sehling 6/1, p. 659):

The people are also at times exhorted to abide in the church for the communion; and thereupon "We believe" is sung, and during it the organ is not played; and next, according to the occasion of the time, the *Credo in unum Deum*, etc. During it the minister goeth again before the altar.

The Liegnitz order of 1542 also has the creed after the sermon, after the Lord's Prayer and the reading of 1 Corinthians 11. **Liegnitz, *Kirchenordnung*, 1542** (Sehling 3, p. 439):

Thereafter the gospel in German, and the song "Come, Holy Ghost," and preach thereon. After the sermon one may sing the Our Father; after that one may read the text of Paul, 1 Corinthians 11, of the Supper, or the sixth chapter of John. Thereupon let the creed be sung.

8.9.3 The creed-hymn to cover the preacher's movement

The creed often covered the preacher's going up into the pulpit or coming down to the altar. **Hadeln, *Kirchenordnung*, 1526** (Sehling 5, p. 468):

When the gospel is finished, let the schoolmaster sing with the choir "We believe," etc.; meanwhile the preacher goeth up into the pulpit.

In Württemberg the creed or a German psalm covered his coming down. **Württemberg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1536** (Sehling 16, p. 107):

But while he cometh down, having ended the sermon, the German creed or a German psalm shall be sung, until the pastor is fully come to the altar where the Supper is to be kept.

8.9.4 "Wir glauben" in the place of "Nun bitten"

At Schweinfurt "Nun bitten" (Now pray we the Holy Ghost) followed the Latin *Patrem* (the Nicene Creed) on most Sundays. In Advent "Wir glauben all" (We all believe) was sung instead. **Schweinfurt, *Gottesdienstordnung*, 1576** (Sehling 11, p. 646):

The choir beginneth the *Patrem*, which being ended there followeth straightway the song "Now pray we the Holy Ghost." N.B.: But in Advent, in the stead of the song "Now pray we," etc., "We all believe in one God," etc. must and shall be sung. N.B.: Through three Sundays of Advent the creed shall be sung.

8.9.5 How fixed the slot was

Fixed. The text was "Wir glauben all" (We all believe), with a sung Apostles' or Nicene Creed as the only alternative. It did not change with the season (Schweinfurt's Advent rule is an exchange between two fixed slots). Its place moved: after the gospel in the Saxon and southern orders, after the sermon in Bugenhagen's northern orders. After the sermon it served as the offertory while the communicants gathered.

8.10 Before the sermon: "Nun bitten wir" and the old *Leisen*

The hymn before the sermon (*ante concionem*) is the second most fixed slot, after the creed. Its hymn is "Nun bitten wir den heiligen Geist" (Now pray we the Holy Ghost). Its function is prayer. Many orders say the people shall "pray an Our Father, or sing" it, or sing it "in place of prayer", "in the stead of prayer". The whole congregation asks for the Holy Ghost before the word is preached, and the preacher often intones it from the pulpit.

On the high feasts the orders put the old pre-Reformation *Leisen* in its place. These are single-stanza vernacular songs ending "Kyrieleis", in use before the Reformation and kept because the people knew them:

Feast	***Leise* (Leise (a vernacular hymn ending Kyrieleis))**
Christmas	"Ein Kindelein so löbelich" (A little child so praiseworthy; or "Gelobet seist du, Jesu Christ" [Praised be thou, Jesus Christ])
Easter	"Christ ist erstanden" (Christ is arisen; or "Also heilig ist der Tag" [Thus holy is this day])
Ascension	"Christ fuhr gen Himmel" (Christ went up to heaven)
Pentecost	"Nun bitten wir" (Now pray we) itself, or "Komm heiliger Geist" (Come, Holy Ghost)
Trinity	"Gott der Vater wohn uns bei" (God the Father, dwell with us)

The pattern is **fixed, with seasonal exchange**. One hymn stands for most of the year and a *Leise* for each high feast and its season. Some orders use the Lord's Prayer hymn in Advent and Lent.

8.10.1 "Nun bitten" as the prayer before the sermon

Buxtehude, *Kirchenordnung*, 1552 (Sehling 7/1, p. 70). It changes the hymn before the sermon through the whole year. The Ascension hymn is "Zu Himmel zu dem Vater mein" (To heaven, to my Father), the ninth stanza of Luther's "Nun freut euch" (Now rejoice):

and before all his sermons [the pastor shall] pray in the manner of a song the prayer "Now pray we the Holy Ghost"; save that the song before the sermon must change according to the occasion of the season: as from Christmas unto Candlemas, "Praised be thou, Jesu Christ"; from Easter unto the Ascension of Christ, "Christ is arisen"; from the Ascension unto Pentecost, "To heaven, to my Father"; from Pentecost again unto Christmas, "Now pray we the Holy Ghost."

The Naumburg order of 1527 sang the first stanza of "Nun bitten" (Now pray we the Holy Ghost) with an added stanza of its own, "Herre Christ, Gottes Sohn" (Lord Christ, Son of God). **Naumburg, *Kirchen-Ordnung* for St Wenzel, 1527** (Sehling 2, p. 60):

then the Holy Ghost is called upon with this song, thus: "Now pray we the Holy Ghost," etc. […] "Lord Christ, Son of God, for thy passion's sake, remember the need of all Christendom; for thou, dear Lord, hast redeemed us on the cross. Kyrieleis." Hereafter the preacher goeth up into the pulpit.

Prussia, *Kirchenordnung und Ceremonien*, 1568 (Sehling 4, p. 79), at the early sermon in Königsberg:

and after the prayer is sung "Now pray we the Holy Ghost," etc.; therewith the pastor goeth up into the pulpit and preacheth the gospel of the season.

In Nördlingen only the first stanza was sung, and the preacher began at once. **Nördlingen, *Kirchenordnung* of Kaspar Löner, 1544** (Sehling 12, p. 312):

But after the creed the whole church shall sing "Now pray we the Holy Ghost," only the first stanza, and the preacher shall preach thereupon.

In Herford the preacher, from the pulpit, bade the people pray an Our Father or sing "Nun bitten", "according as the feasts are". **Herford, *Kirchenordnung*, 1532** (Sehling 21, p. 176):

Then the preacher goeth up into the pulpit and exhorteth to say a *Pater noster*, or to sing "Now pray we the Holy Ghost," etc., according as the feasts are, Easter, Pentecost, Christmas, etc.

The Pfalz-Zweibrücken plan of 1565 has "Nun bitten" before the sermon every Sunday of the Trinity season, "one day as the other", and says so twice (Sehling 18, p. 340):

Before the sermon: "Now pray we," etc., one day as the other. […] Note: and thereafter on every Sunday before the sermon, until Christmas, "Now pray we," etc. shall be sung.

For Christmas the same plan gives the *Leise* (Leise (a vernacular hymn ending Kyrieleis)) instead, until Candlemas, and then "Nun bitten" again until Easter (Sehling 18, p. 340):

So, *mutatis mutandis*, shall it be kept on the days following; also "The little Child" shall be sung always before the sermon until the Purification of Mary, and thereafter until Easter, "Now pray we," etc.

At Hof, on Good Friday, "Nun bitten" was dropped and the last stanza of the Passion hymn "Gott dem Vater sei Lob" (To God the Father be praise) was sung kneeling in its place. **Hof, *Ordo ecclesiasticus*, 1592** (Sehling 11, p. 439):

In the place of the *Patrem* (the Nicene Creed): "To God the Father be praise, and to the Son"; the last verse of this song is sung on bended knees, in the place of "Now pray we." "Now pray we" is omitted. After the sermon: "O Lamb of God, innocent."

8.10.2 The *Leisen* at the high feasts, sung from the pulpit

A family of orders runs from Mecklenburg (1552) through Lüneburg (1564) and Wolfenbüttel (1569) to Oldenburg (1573). In all of them the old German songs of the three feasts are sung by the preachers "from the pulpit, when they begin the sermon, with the people". **Mecklenburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1552** (Sehling 5, p. 200):

the old little German songs, as on the Nativity "A little Child so worthy of praise," at Easter "Christ is arisen," item "So holy is the day," at Pentecost "Now pray we," etc. And these also the preachers shall sing with the people from the pulpit, when they begin the sermon.

Lüneburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1564 (Sehling 6/1, p. 545):

Thereupon one shall say an Our Father, or sing "Now pray we the Holy Ghost"; about Christmas, "A little Child so worthy of praise," etc.; about Easter, "Christ is arisen," etc.

The Lüneburg city order of 1575 calls these *Leisen* a "motet". **Lüneburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1575** (Sehling 6/1, p. 659):

next the gospel is sung in German; thereupon a "motet": at holy Christmas, "A little Child so worthy of praise"; about Easter, "Christ is arisen"; at the Ascension, "Christ went up to heaven"; about Pentecost and otherwise the year through, "Now pray we the Holy Ghost."

In Kurland the pastor intoned the *Leise* (Leise (a vernacular hymn ending Kyrieleis)) from the pulpit "after old custom". The list includes Simeon's song for the Purification. **Kurland, *Kirchenordnung*, 1570** (Sehling 5, p. 88):

And when the feast days are at hand, the song of praise before the sermon is to be intoned in the pulpit after the old custom: "Praised be thou, Jesu Christ"; "A little Child so worthy of praise"; "Lord, now lettest thou thy servant"; "Christ is arisen"; "Christ went up to heaven"; "Now pray we the Holy Ghost," at and after Pentecost as long as one will; at Trinity, "God the Father be with us," etc.

Hoya had "Gelobet seist du" (Praised be thou, Jesus Christ) sung three times running at Christmas. For Trinity it had "O Vater unser, gnädiger Gott" (O our Father, gracious God), which then served "the whole summer through". **Hoya, *Kirchenordnung*, 1581** (Sehling 6/2, pp. 1148–1149):

At the beginning of the sermon on the high feasts the old, accustomed songs are sung in the pulpit: at Easter "Christ is arisen," etc.; at Christmas "Praised be thou, Jesu Christ," etc., three times one after another; at Pentecost "Now pray we the Holy Ghost" with the verses following; on the day of the Holy Trinity "O Father of ours, gracious God," together with the two verses following. And the said song so the whole summer through.

Hildesheim (Stift), *Kirchenordnung für Steuerwald und Peine*, 1561 (Sehling 7/2.1, p. 782):

when that is out, the whole congregation singeth "We believe," and thereupon "Now pray we the Holy Ghost" or "Come, Holy Ghost"; at Christmas until Candlemas, "A little Child so worthy of praise"; at Easter until Pentecost, "Christ is arisen"; thereupon followeth the sermon.

Schwarzburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1574 (Sehling 2, p. 133):

But on the high feasts he singeth from the pulpit with all the people a short song which is ordained for such feast: as at Christmas, "A little Child so worthy of praise"; at Easter, "Christ is arisen"; at Pentecost, "Now pray we the Holy Ghost"; at Trinity, "God the Father be with us."

Worms, *Agendbüchlein*, 1560 (Sehling 19/1, p. 206):

thereupon the choir singeth "Now pray we the Holy Ghost"; or, if it be on high feasts, one of the German songs of the same ordained for the feasts, as at Christmas "A little Child so worthy of praise," at Easter "Christ is arisen," etc. After the song the sermon followeth straightway.

Bugenhagen's Braunschweig order of 1528 already has "Christ ist erstanden" (Christ is arisen) at the start of the Easter sermon, "after the accustomed manner", while "Christ lag" was farced into *Victimae* (§8.8.3). The Hamburg order of 1529 repeats the rule (§8.8.3).

The Hessian *Agende* (Philippist) gives the congregation's prayer before the sermon as the Lord's Prayer or a *Leise*. **Hessen, *Agende*, 1574** (Philippist; Sehling 8, p. 412):

the whole church singeth with one accord the Our Father, or another accustomed song according to the occasion of the season, as: "A little Child so worthy of praise," "Christ is arisen," "Christ went up to heaven," "Now pray we the Holy Ghost," etc.

Verden's order has the preacher start the hymn himself and the congregation sing it to the end. **Verden, *Kirchenordnung*, 1606** (Sehling 7/1, pp. 156–157):

At times, in the stead of the Our Father, he may begin the psalm "Now pray we the Holy Ghost" and sing it to the end with the congregation. At Christmas one shall sing "A little Child so worthy of praise"; at Easter "So holy is the day" or "Christ is arisen"; at the Ascension "Christ went up to heaven"; at Pentecost "Now pray we the Holy Ghost," item "Come, Holy Ghost, Lord God"; at Trinity "God the Father be with us," etc.

8.10.3 Seasonal tables for the slot: the Lord's Prayer in Advent and Lent

Several orders give the whole year. In Lent (Lippe) or in Advent and Lent (Solms-Laubach) the Lord's Prayer hymn (Luther's "Vater unser im Himmelreich", or another Our Father song) takes the place of "Nun bitten" (Now pray we the Holy Ghost). **Lippe, *Kirchenordnung*, 1571** (Sehling 21, p. 387):

then shall the church say an Our Father, or sing, in the stead of prayer, the accustomed songs according to the occasion of the season and feasts: as at Easter, "Christ is arisen," until Pentecost; from Pentecost until Christmas, "Now pray we the Holy Ghost"; at the Nativity of Christ, "A little Child so worthy of praise," until the Sundays of Lent. But through Lent the Our Father, or else another prayer-psalm, shall be sung.

Solms-Laubach, *Kirchenordnung* [1576–1580] (Sehling 9, pp. 359–360):

and thereupon the sermon is begun, and after the preface is sung, from Christmas until the Purification of Mary, "A little Child so worthy of praise," etc.; from the Purification until Easter, "Our Father, who art in heaven"; from Easter until the Ascension, "Christ is arisen"; from the Ascension until Pentecost, "Christ went up to heaven"; from Pentecost until Advent, "Now pray we the Holy Ghost" and "God the Father be with us," etc.; from Advent until Christmas, "Our Father, who art in heaven," etc.

Tangermünde (1603) keeps the Christmas *Leise* (Leise (a vernacular hymn ending Kyrieleis)) on every Sunday until Candlemas. **Tangermünde, *Ritus*, 1603** (Sehling 3, p. 339):

before the sermon is sung "The day that is so full of joy," etc., or another agreeable to the feast. Moreover, from this feast on the Sundays until the feast of the Purification, before the midday sermon is sung "A little Child so," etc., or another of the season.

The Ysenburg-Birstein order uses the Lord's Prayer hymn from Trinity until Christmas. **Ysenburg-Birstein, *Kirchenordnung*, 1588** (Sehling 10, p. 620):

the Christian congregation singeth or prayeth with him the Our Father, or instead of it a short song fitting every season of the year, as at Christmas "A little Child so worthy of praise," etc.; at Easter "Christ is arisen," etc.; at the Ascension of the Lord "Christ went up to heaven"; and at Pentecost "Now pray we the Holy Ghost," etc.

Pomerania, *Kirchenordnung*, 1542 (Sehling 4, p. 356):

and say an Our Father, or sing the song of praise "Come, Holy Ghost, Lord God," etc.; at Christmas, "A little Child so worthy of praise"; at Easter, "Christ is arisen"; at Pentecost, "Now pray we the Holy Ghost."

Transylvanian Saxons, *Kirchenordnung*, 1547, German text (Sehling 24, p. 244):

After this office the first sermon is commonly held in the towns, before which something is always sung, as "The day that is so full of joy," or "Christ is arisen," or "Of the Holy Ghost," or else a psalm, as the season of the year bringeth. After the sermon something is sung again after the same season, or for peace, and the like.

Waldeck sets the Lord's Prayer hymn, the Ten Commandments hymn, a seasonal German song and the creed before the chief sermon. **Waldeck, *Kirchenordnung*, 1556** (Sehling 9, p. 273):

Before the high sermon the pastor, sexton and congregation shall sing Martin Luther's Our Father, "Our Father in the kingdom of heaven, who all of us," etc.; thereupon the Ten Commandments; a German song and collects out of Veit Dietrich or others, proved according to the occasion of the season; following, the creed.

8.10.4 Chosen to fit the sermon

A few orders choose the hymn before the sermon by the sermon itself. At Thorn it was "a German song of the season, or what the text in hand and the common need required". **Thorn, *Kirchenordnung*, 1575** (Sehling 4, p. 237):

when the preacher goeth up into the pulpit, the people shall first be exhorted to prayer, and a German song of the season, or what the text in hand and the common need required, be sung, an Our Father also prayed, and following that the sermon set forward.

Brieg asks that the hymn "agree with the sermon as much as possible", but not at the cost of the songs the people already know. **Brieg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1592** (Sehling 3, p. 446):

In the pulpit at the office the pastor shall begin the sermon with a Christian song and an Our Father; but the song shall agree with the sermon as much as possible; and hereby other good Christian songs which are known to the common man shall not be put under.

The Hohenlohe *Gesangsordnung* of 1596 gives a menu for this slot. "Nun bitten" (Now pray we the Holy Ghost), "Wir glauben all" (We all believe) or the sung Apostles' Creed are the defaults. The last two stanzas of "Es ist das Heil" (Salvation has come to us) can be sung if its first stanzas were sung before the lesson. Several psalm-hymns can be chosen "if it may fit the following sermon". **Hohenlohe, *Schul- und Gesangsordnung*, 1596** (Sehling 15, p. 653):

before the sermon the schoolmaster shall sing "Now pray we," etc., or "We all believe," etc., or "I believe in God," etc.; or (where "Salvation now is come to us," etc. was sung before the lesson) finish the two last stanzas of the same song, "Praise and honour," etc.; or (where it may fit the following sermon) "Lord Christ, the only," etc., "Out of the depths," etc., "Now they that here their hope," etc.; or out of Lobwasser's psalm book the thirty-third psalm, as far as the seventh verse.

8.10.5 To cover the preacher's going up

As with the creed (§8.9.3), the hymn before the sermon often filled the time while the preacher climbed the pulpit. **Heilbronn, draft *Gottesdienstordnung*, 1532** (Sehling 17/1, p. 301):

Thereupon the people sing a German psalm, or on a feast day a German song of praise after the feast; meanwhile the preacher goeth up into the pulpit.

Weißenburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1528 (Sehling 11, p. 659):

then let the schoolmaster sing the German creed or "Come, Holy Ghost"; meanwhile let the minister go up into the pulpit and expound the gospel.

8.10.6 How fixed the slot was

Fixed, with seasonal exchange. Outside the festal seasons the hymn was "Nun bitten wir" (Now pray we), with "Komm heiliger Geist" (Come, Holy Ghost) or the Lord's Prayer hymn as the alternative. At the three (or four, or five) high feasts the old *Leise* (Leise (a vernacular hymn ending Kyrieleis)) of the feast took its place, often for the whole season to the next feast. Only a few late orders (Thorn 1575, Brieg 1592, Hohenlohe 1596) let the sermon decide the hymn in this slot.

8.11 After the sermon: "Erhalt uns", the offertory, and the hymn that answers the sermon

The slot after the sermon (*post concionem*) did three jobs.

1. It was a prayer after the sermon, most often "Erhalt uns, Herr, bei deinem Wort" (Keep us, Lord, by thy word). This was Luther's 1541/42 hymn "against the two arch-enemies of Christ and his holy Church, the Pope and the Turk", as the Pfalz-Zweibrücken songbook heads it.
2. It filled the old place of the offertory. The communicants came forward and the bread and wine were made ready while the people sang.
3. It covered the preacher's coming down from the pulpit, or his vesting for the altar.

Later orders added a fourth: to answer the sermon with a hymn on the same doctrine.

8.11.1 "Erhalt uns, Herr, bei deinem Wort"

Prussia sang "Erhalt uns" (Keep us) after every sermon and gave the reason: to pray that God would not let his word be taken away. **Prussia, *Kirchenordnung und Ceremonien*, 1568** (Sehling 4, p. 81):

When the same is out, the whole church singeth, as after every sermon always, "Keep us, Lord, by thy word," etc., that the godly, faithful God may be humbly prayed that he suffer not his word to be taken from us, but [keep] the same against all resistance of all sects and tyrants, which under the names of the Pope and the Turk [...].

In the Prussian villages the same hymn covered the priest's walk to the altar (Sehling 4, p. 84):

After the prayer the whole church singeth always "Keep us, Lord, by thy word," etc., as is mentioned above. Meanwhile the priest goeth from the pulpit before the altar.

The Schweinfurt order of 1543 quotes the hymn's first lines, with the Pope and the Turk. **Schweinfurt, *Kirchenordnung*, 1543** (Sehling 11, p. 641):

When now the sermon is out, one shall sing thereupon: "Keep us, Lord, by thy word, and curb the Pope's and Turk's murder," etc.

Schönburg sang it "when pressing need is at hand, as alas in these last times". **Schönburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1542** (Sehling 2, p. 171):

After the sermon the organist playeth somewhat, until the priest cometh to the altar and hath prepared the bread and the cup to be offered. But when pressing need is at hand, as alas in these last times, the schoolmaster shall always, at the end of the sermon, begin to sing with the whole church: "Keep us, Lord, by thy word," etc.; "Grant us peace," etc.

In Reuss the hymn after the sermon was always a song "for the common peace", begun from the pulpit. **Reuss, *Kirchen-Ordnung* of Heinrich IV, 30 August 1552** (Sehling 2, pp. 153–154):

After the sermon a song for the common peace shall always be begun in the pulpit, […] as: "Keep us, Lord, by thy," etc.; "Grant us peace," etc.; "O Lord God, give [us thy peace]."

Ritzebüttel, *Kirchenordnung*, 1556 (Sehling 5, p. 558):

After the sermon is sung "Keep us, Lord, by thy word" to the end, or another German psalm of David according to the occasion of the season, with the collect following: "Lord God, give peace in thy land."

The Hoya order of 1581 (Sehling 6/2, p. 1149) and the Hildesheim chapter order of 1561 (Sehling 7/2.1, p. 782; see §8.10.2) likewise set "Erhalt uns" after the sermon.

8.11.2 To cover the preacher's coming down, or his vesting

In Prussia (1544) the hymn after the sermon gave the priest time to come down from the pulpit, "take a little breath", and find his way back to the altar. **Prussia, *Kirchenordnung*, 1544** (Sehling 4, p. 65):

Straightway after the sermon, where the litany is not held, the whole church singeth a Christian song, as "Now rejoice, dear Christians all," "Now praise, my soul, the Lord," or the Our Father word for word without exposition, after the melody of the lord bishop of Pomesania, Doctor Paul Speratus. Meanwhile the priest goeth from the pulpit, may take a little breath, and find himself again at the altar.

At Verden the preacher who was to celebrate put his vestments back on while the congregation sang out the hymn he had begun. **Verden, *Kirchenordnung*, 1606** (Sehling 7/1, pp. 157–158):

When now the sermon is ended and the common prayer performed, the preacher shall then begin in the pulpit a psalm, as "God the Father be with us," etc., or "May God be gracious unto us," item "Praise and honour with high price," etc., or another according to the occasion of the season. And the same shall be sung fully out to the end by the choir or the congregation. But meanwhile the preacher who will hold the office and perform the communion shall put on again his church vestment.

Hessen, *Agende*, 1574 (Philippist; Sehling 8, p. 412). The Corvey order of 1603 copies it:

Here the pastor goeth down from the pulpit, and meanwhile the Christian song of praise is sung, "Praise the Lord, all ye heathen," etc., or else another short Christian song, as "God the Father be with us," etc.

Weißenburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1528 (Sehling 11, p. 659):

then let the schoolmaster begin to sing a short psalm, "May God be gracious unto us," or "Now pray we the Holy Ghost," or else what pleaseth him, that is short. Meanwhile the minister goeth from the pulpit to the altar.

Hadeln, *Kirchenordnung*, 1526 (Sehling 5, p. 468):

In the coming down from the pulpit the schoolmaster singeth a psalm.

8.11.3 A hymn in the place of the offertory

The Latin offertory chant was a proper, and most orders dropped it because of its sacrificial texts. In many orders a German hymn took its place, sung while the bread and wine were prepared. Calenberg says so in the rubric of its printed Mass. **Calenberg-Göttingen, *Kirchenordnung*, 1542** (Sehling 6/2, p. 814):

Thereafter the priest goeth again before the altar, and the choir singeth in the meantime "May God be gracious unto us," etc., or "God the Father be with us," etc. […] Thereafter followeth the offertory. In the stead of the offertory a German psalm shall be sung with the congregation.

The same order's German Christmas Mass names the hymn (Sehling 6/2, p. 821):

Offertory. In the stead of the offertory let "A little Child so worthy of praise," etc. be sung.

The rubric in the general part of the order gives the reason: the priest must make himself ready and prepare everything for the communion (Sehling 6/2, p. 795):

And because he must there make himself ready for the communion and prepare all things, the congregation shall meanwhile sing a fine German psalm.

Dortmund, *Gottesdienstordnung*, 1554 (Sehling 21, p. 209):

After the sermon one may again sing a fitting song of praise for the offertory.

Lippe, *Deutsche Messe* [c. 1525–1538] (Sehling 22, p. 568):

The offertory. For the offertory a spiritual song is sung, that is, a psalm.

The Naumburg order of 1527 sang "Aus tiefer Not" (Out of deep distress) in the place of the offertory. **Naumburg, *Kirchen-Ordnung* for St Wenzel, 1527** (Sehling 2, p. 60):

then one beginneth, in the stead of the offertory, to sing through the whole church the psalm of David put into German, *De profundis clamavi ad te* (Out of the depths have I cried unto thee), etc., as followeth: "Out of the depths I cry to thee."

The Brandenburg order of 1540 kept the Latin offertory of the day in the collegiate churches and let the villages sing a German psalm instead. **Brandenburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1540** (Sehling 3, p. 71):

and after the sermon is ended, the offertory of the Sunday or feast; but in the villages one may sing a German psalm for it.

In Corvinus's Lippe order the people sang Psalm 67 or "Dank sagen wir alle" (Let us all give thanks to God) while the priest made ready the wine and bread. **Lippe, *Kirchenordnung* of Antonius Corvinus [1542]** (Sehling 21, p. 345):

After the confession is done, the people sing "May God be gracious unto us," or "Thanks say we all," etc.; meanwhile the priest maketh ready wine and bread for the communicants.

In the Lutheran East Frisian liturgy of Engerhafe, organ and congregation sang "Herr Christ, der einig Gottessohn" (Lord Christ, the only Son of God) in alternation while the communicants came to the table. **Engerhafe, *Liturgie*, 1583** (Sehling 7/1, p. 677):

Thereafter let the pastor go to the table of the Lord, prepare the bread and pour the wine into the cup. But let the organist and the church sing by turns the hymn "Lord Christ, the only Son of God," and meanwhile the communicants may come together to the table.

The Albertine order for Celle kept Latin here, with the people kneeling in prayer "in the stead of the offertory". **Albertine Saxony, *Die Cellischen Ordnungen*, 1545** (Sehling 1, p. 300):

One might also at times change about and sing another pure Latin song for it. During this song written above the people shall kneel down and make their prayers in the stead of the offertory.

8.11.4 While the communicants come forward

Many orders tie the hymn to the movement of the communicants into the choir. It is sung "until they all kneel". **Anhalt, *Kirchen-Ordnung* of Princes Johann and Georg, 3 August 1548** (Sehling 2, p. 554):

After the sermon, while the communicants go into the choir, the men to the right, the women to the left hand, a German psalm shall be sung until they all [kneel].

Soest, *Kirchenordnung*, 1532 (Sehling 22, p. 450):

until the sermon is ended; then a short psalm shall be sung; meanwhile they go into the choir and set themselves down upon their knees.

Nördlingen, *Kirchenordnung* of Kaspar Löner, 1544 (Sehling 12, p. 312):

After the sermon the choir shall sing a little German song, until the celebrant hath prepared the cup and the hosts for communicating; and the communicants shall find themselves before the altar.

Pomerania (1535) used the Ten Commandments hymn or *Da pacem* (Give peace). **Pomerania, *Kirchenordnung*, 1535** (Sehling 4, p. 341):

When all that is out, one singeth of the ten commandments of God, or *Da pacem* in Latin and German, or else somewhat other. Meanwhile the communicants betake themselves to the altar, the men on the right hand, the women on the left.

Brieg asked that this hymn, too, agree with the sermon. **Brieg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1592** (Sehling 3, p. 446):

After the sermon the cantor shall sing a German song, that the communicants may find their way to the altar; but the song also shall agree with the sermon.

8.11.5 A hymn to answer the sermon

The Mecklenburg order of 1545 wanted a short hymn after the sermon, "commonly a prayer, which the whole congregation can sing". **Mecklenburg, *Ordeninge der misse*, 1545** (Sehling 5, p. 154):

the pastor shall, after the prayer spoken, begin a psalm that is not long, commonly a prayer, which the whole congregation can sing, as: "May God be gracious unto us," "Lord Christ," etc., "What need can come upon us."

Later orders ask that it agree with the sermon's teaching. **Rostock, *Conformitas ceremoniarum*, c. 1560** (Sehling 5, p. 288):

After the sermon and the prayer the pastor shall begin a psalm which shall agree with the teaching of the gospel.

The Hanau-Lichtenberg order gives examples by Sunday. **Hanau-Lichtenberg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1573** (Sehling 20/2, p. 54):

III. The sermon shall always be concluded with a song which agreeth and rhymeth therewith: as on Misericordias Domini one singeth "Out of the depths"; on Jubilate, "Ah God, from heaven look down"; on Cantate, "A mighty fortress"; on Trinity, "God the Father be with us," etc.

In Marienhafe the hymn after the blessing was one "agreeing with the sermon". **Marienhafe, *Kirchenordnung*, 1593** (Sehling 7/1, p. 697):

following that the blessing spoken, and thereupon a psalm or song agreeing with the sermon, begun with the organ and sung out by choir and congregation, etc.

The Hohenlohe *Gesangsordnung* of 1596 has the schoolmaster ready with a hymn chosen by the doctrinal article the sermon chiefly treated. It gives twelve articles, each with its hymns. **Hohenlohe, *Schul- und Gesangsordnung*, 1596** (Sehling 15, p. 653):

On Sundays, as also on common holy days, after the sermon the schoolmaster shall again be provided with a song: as, when the sermon had been directed chiefly to the article (1) of the word and sacraments, "The Lord is my faithful shepherd," etc., "O God, thou highest treasury of grace," etc., "God the Father," etc., out of Lobwasser the ninety-third psalm, "God as a king," etc.; (2) of the law and good works, "Lord Christ, the only [Son] of God," etc., "O God, thou highest," etc., "Now pray we."

The list goes on through the articles on the gospel, sin and the merit of Christ, prayer, the cross, persecution, earthly want and blessing, the transience of life, the pestilence, idolatry, and the last day. When many communicants were waiting, a short hymn was to be sung instead (Sehling 15, p. 654):

But in case there were many communicants on the Sunday, then for brevity's sake: "Thanks say we all," etc., or out of Lobwasser the ninety-third psalm, "God as a king," etc., the hundredth, "Ye peoples on the earth all," etc., or the hundred and seventeenth, "Praise ye the Lord," etc., or the hundred and twenty-first, "Mine eyes I," etc.

Reutlingen wanted variety here. It asked for "not always the old common fiddle", "Es woll uns Gott genädig sein" (May God be gracious to us), even though that too was a fine psalm. **Reutlingen, *Ordnung der Schule und des Kirchengesangs*, 1565/1566** (Sehling 17/2, p. 49):

After the sermon, when there is to be communion, they shall sing "Glory be to the Father," etc., or "Praise and honour with high price," etc.; and where there is no communion, again a fair psalm, and not only always the old common fiddle, "May God be gracious unto us"; which fair, glorious psalm yet shall not be left off, but be sung at times like the others.

The Reutlingen school visitation of 1574 asked for a hymn "agreeable to the season or to the text preached", and not a weary repetition of the one sung before the sermon. **Reutlingen, *Artikel der Schulvisitation*, 1574** (Sehling 17/2, p. 58):

Item, there shall always after the sermon, especially when the holy Supper is not held, be sung a separate song or psalm of about three or four stanzas, less or more, agreeable to the season or to the text preached; and the one sung before the sermon (notwithstanding that it was not brought quite to the end) shall not be repeated to weariness, as hath hitherto often been done.

8.11.6 One hymn split around the sermon

Some orders split a single hymn: the first stanzas before the sermon and the rest after it. The Naumburg order does this with the Lord's Prayer hymn. **Naumburg, *Kirchen-Ordnung* for St Wenzel, 1537/1538** (Sehling 2, p. 72):

Thereupon a short psalm according to the season; or "Grant us peace graciously," "May God be gracious unto us," the last three stanzas of "Now pray we the Holy Ghost," and on the other high feasts of the season, item "Keep us, Lord, by thy word," the last six stanzas of the Our Father, when the first three have been sung before the sermon.

Anhalt, *Ordnung der deutschen Gesänge*, before 8 February 1551 (Sehling 2, p. 556), for Christmas:

On Christmas Day and some days after, let three verses of the song of praise "Praised be thou, Jesu Christ," etc. be sung before the early sermon, and the other verses after the sermon; in the Mass before the gospel let "Praised be thou, Jesu Christ" be sung through entire.

The German school order of Öhringen had the schoolmaster sing, after the sermon, the last stanza of the hymn he had sung before it. **Öhringen, *Kirchen- und Schulordnungen*, 1582** (Sehling 15, p. 503):

he shall sing a psalm, as "O Lord God, be gracious unto me," etc., or "Salvation now is come to us," etc., and the like. […] After the sermon the last stanza of the foregoing psalm, as "Praise and honour with high price," or the like, somewhat short.

At Neuenrade, in Holy Week, the Passion hymn "Gott dem Vater sei Lob" (To God the Father be praise) was sung to its fifteenth stanza before the sermon and taken up again there after it (Sehling 22, p. 531). The funeral orders of Schwäbisch Hall and Limpurg split the burial hymn in the same way (§8.17.4).

8.11.7 How fixed the slot was

A handful, with a trend toward the variable. The Saxon, Prussian and northern orders mostly fixed the slot on "Erhalt uns" (Keep us), with "Verleih uns Frieden" (Grant us peace), "Es woll uns Gott" (May God be gracious to us) or "Gott der Vater wohn uns bei" (God the Father, dwell with us) as the alternatives. Where it was the offertory, any "German psalm" would do. From the 1560s the Upper German, Hessian (Moderate Reformed), Hohenlohe and East Frisian orders increasingly wanted a hymn chosen to answer the sermon. That is the most topical choice of hymn anywhere in the service.

8.12 The Sanctus: "Jesaia dem Propheten" and "Heilig ist Gott der Vater"

The German Sanctus had two forms:

- Luther's "Jesaia dem Propheten das geschah" (1526). This is a rhymed narrative of Isaiah 6, printed in the *Deutsche Messe* (German Mass).

- A troped Trinitarian Sanctus, "Heilig ist Gott der Vater, heilig ist Gott der Sohn, heilig ist Gott der Heilige Geist" (Holy is God the Father, holy is God the Son, holy is God the Holy Ghost), printed in Low German in Bugenhagen's Wolfenbüttel order. Sehling's editors give it to Decius or call it anonymous (§8.12.2).

The Latin Sanctus stayed in towns with schools and on feasts. In most orders the German Sanctus followed the sermon and exhortation and led straight into the communion. In some it was sung during the distribution itself (§8.14).

8.12.1 "Jesaia dem Propheten" as the communicants come forward

Prussia, *Kirchenordnung*, 1544 (Sehling 4, p. 65):

Thereupon the choir or the church singeth the German Sanctus, or the song "Isaiah the prophet, it befell," during which those that will communicate straightway step to the altar. And the priest need not elevate the sacrament, for the elevation is herein unneedful, and for this cause is done away.

Nördlingen, *Ordnung der ceremonien* at St George's, 1555 (Sehling 12, p. 319):

The Sanctus out of Isaiah in German, that the people may gather in the choir for the communion.

Pomerania had the boys intone the words "Holy is God the Lord of Sabaoth" inside Luther's hymn, with the choir answering. **Pomerania, *Agenda*, 1569** (Sehling 4, p. 438):

The pastor shall also see to it that in the stead of the Sanctus there be often sung "Isaiah the prophet, it befell," etc., and that the boys alone intone the Sanctus therein and the choir answer.

Wittgenstein gives "Dank sagen wir alle" (Let us all give thanks to God) as an alternative in this slot. **Wittgenstein, *Kirchenordnung*, 1563** (Sehling 22, p. 103):

After the sermon is performed, let the song of praise be begun: "Isaiah the prophet, it befell," etc., or "Thanks say we all," etc.

The later Kurpfalz text of 1577 gives the choice between "the Sanctus, To Isaiah the prophet, Grates nunc omnes, Let us all give thanks, or another short song of the kind" (Sehling 14, p. 149, apparatus).

In Calenberg's German Masses the priest prayed a collect for the authorities in silence while the Sanctus hymn was sung. **Calenberg-Göttingen, *Kirchenordnung*, 1542**, the German Christmas Mass (Sehling 6/2, p. 821):

Hereupon followeth the Sanctus, "Isaiah the prophet …". The collect which the priest prayeth during the Sanctus: "Merciful heavenly Father …"

8.12.2 The Trinitarian German Sanctus

Five orders name the Trinitarian Sanctus: Wolfenbüttel 1543, Mecklenburg 1545, Stralsund 1555, Harlingerland 1573/74 and Hof 1592. The first three give it in Low German, "Hillich is Got, de Vader" (Holy is God the Father). Sehling's editors differ on its author:

- The Hildesheim editor calls it "this anonymous Sanctus". The editor finds it in High German in the *Newe deudsche geistliche Gesenge* (New German Spiritual Songs) that Georg Rhau published for the schools (Sehling 7/2.1, p. 856, n. 34). The Hof register names the same collection (Sehling 11, p. 750).
- The Harlingerland editor takes it for Decius's song setting of the Sanctus, probably written in 1522/23 and printed in Joachim Slüter's Rostock songbook of 1531 as "Hyllich ys Godt de vader / hyllich ys Godt de söne" (Holy is God the Father, holy is God the Son). The editor adds that Ph. J. Rehtmeyer named Decius as the author of a High German form in 1710, and said it was by then little used (Sehling 7/1, p. 739, n. 3).

Wolfenbüttel, *Kirchenordnung*, 1543 (Sehling 6/1, p. 59):

After the Latin preface the whole church may joyfully sing the German Sanctus. (Notes:) "Holy is God the Father, holy is God the Son, holy is God the Holy Ghost. He is the Lord of Sabaoth. All the world is full of his glory. Hosanna in the highest. Blessed be he that cometh in the name of the Lord. Hosanna in the highest." (End of notes.) Such German Sanctus may well be sung another time also, or at all times, during the communion alongside other songs.

Stralsund kept the Latin Sanctus for feasts and the two German forms for the rest of the year. **Stralsund, draft *Kirchenordnung*, 1555** (Sehling 4, p. 551):

On the feasts the Sanctus and Agnus Dei are sung at times; and at the other times in German, "Holy is God the Father," and as Doctor Martin hath also put it into German out of the prophet Isaiah.

Mecklenburg allowed the towns to take the Sanctus melodies set in the songbooks for the feasts, matched to their Kyries. The villages sang "Jesaia" or "Heilig ist Gott der Vater" (Holy is God the Father). **Mecklenburg, *Ordeninge der misse*, 1545** (Sehling 5, p. 154):

After the preface one singeth in the towns the Sanctus in Latin, at times "Isaiah the prophet." Neither is it needful always to sing one Sanctus in Latin; but at times take those which in the songbooks of the great feasts are appointed to the Kyries. In the villages let "Isaiah" be sung, or the other, "Holy is God the Father," which may also be sung at times in the towns.

In Harlingerland three boys knelt to sing the Benedictus. The *Et homo factus est* (And was made man) of the creed was sung the same way. **Harlingerland, *Kirchenordnung*, 1573/74** (Sehling 7/1, p. 738):

Before the communion we ordain to be sung the Sanctus in Latin and German, as the same is to be found in the said psalm book of Luther; and that with special devotion, by three boys kneeling, the Benedictus, and in the creed the *Et homo factus est*, shall be sung, as the same hath hitherto been customary.

During the communion Harlingerland had "Heilig ist Gott der Vater" sung in turn with the other communion hymns, in the choir and below in the church. **Harlingerland, *Kirchenordnung*, 1573/74** (Sehling 7/1, p. 739):

During the communion we will that there be sung "Jesus Christ our Saviour," etc., "God be praised and blessed," etc., "O Lamb of God," etc., "Holy is God the Father," etc., one after the other, in the choir and below in the church.

Hof sang it in four parts during the communion, from its choirbooks: on St John the Baptist's day and at the dedication of St Michael's church. At Epiphany "the German Sanctus for four voices" might go before the communion motet. **Hof, *Ordo ecclesiasticus*, 1592** (Sehling 11, pp. 458, 466, 468):

During the communion: *Magi viderunt stellam*, for four voices, by L. de Victoria. Let the German Sanctus for four voices go before, if need require.

During the communion: the Sanctus of the foregoing Mass, or the German Sanctus, "Holy is God the Father," for four voices, in the clasped [books].

During the communion: the German Sanctus, "Holy is God the Father," for four voices, in the black clasped part-books.

Sehling's editor finds it hard to say which of the books in Widmann's list are meant, and says they no longer survive (Sehling 11, p. 466, n. 17).

Not in Advent. No order assigns "Heilig ist Gott der Vater" to Advent, or to any season. The rules the orders give are of rank and place:

- Stralsund keeps the Latin Sanctus for the feasts and sings the German forms "at the other times";
- Mecklenburg gives it to the villages, and to the towns "at times";
- Wolfenbüttel allows it after the preface, or during the communion "at all times";
- Harlingerland sings it in turn with the communion hymns;
- Hof sings it in parts on two feasts, and perhaps at Epiphany.

In Advent Hof's communion has instead the *Sanctus et Agnus angelicum* (the angelic Sanctus and Agnus Dei), on the first three Sundays (Sehling 11, pp. 432–433). *Angelicum* ("angelic") names a plainsong melody, not a text: Sehling's editor glosses the *Benedicamus angelicum* as "name of a melody" (Sehling 11, p. 412, n. 13), and the Latin school sings the Kyrie *angelicum* (angelic [Kyrie]) "in the Advent of the Lord" (Sehling 11, p. 472). The Hof *Kirchenamt* sang it in German. On the first Sunday the Kyrie *angelicum seu feriale* (angelic or ferial) is noted with "Lord, have mercy upon us", and the Sanctus notes begin "Holy" (Sehling 11, p. 432). The same Sanctus is not kept to Advent. Hof sings it "as in Advent" on the Epiphany Sundays and at the Annunciation (pp. 435, 439), and the *Sanctus et Agnus angelicum* on Trinity Sunday and the first Sundays after it, on the feasts of St John the Baptist, St Laurence, the Visitation and the Virgin, and of the apostles and martyrs (pp. 442–450). The other grades are the

dominicale (Sunday [Kyrie]) from the fourth Sunday after Trinity (pp. 443–445) and the *quadragesimale* (Lenten [grade]) in Lent (p. 439).

8.12.3 At the elevation

Brandenburg kept the elevation. After it the collegiate churches sang the Latin responsory *Tua est potentia* (Thine is the power) and the parishes a German hymn. **Brandenburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1540** (Sehling 3, p. 69):

After the elevation one shall sing in cathedrals and collegiate churches a Latin song, as the responsory *Tua est potentia*, etc.; but in the parishes a German song, "May God be gracious unto us," or "Praise and thanks with high price."

The bells rung at the elevation are treated in Chapter 9, §9.5.4.

8.12.4 In the place of Sanctus and Agnus

Hof allowed "Jesaia" in the place of the Latin Sanctus and Agnus, or after them when there were many communicants. At Christmas it used "Vom Himmel hoch" (From heaven high I come here). **Hof, *Ordo ecclesiasticus*, 1592** (Sehling 11, p. 426):

Sometimes in the place of the Sanctus and Agnus (or also, when many are present who partake of the body and blood of Christ, after them) is sung "Isaiah the prophet, it befell."

8.12.5 How fixed the slot was

Fixed. The choice was between the Latin Sanctus (graded, on feasts), Luther's "Jesaia", and the Trinitarian "Heilig ist Gott der Vater" (Holy is God the Father). Rarely a hymn of thanks ("Dank sagen wir alle", *Grates nunc omnes*) or a hymn of prayer at the elevation takes its place.

8.13 The Lord's Prayer and the Words of Institution

No troped or farced Paternoster or Words of Institution were found in the corpus. The Verba were sung by the priest to Luther's tones, or read. The Lord's Prayer was often sung by the priest in German, and sometimes by the whole congregation as Luther's metrical "Vater unser im Himmelreich" (Our Father in the kingdom of heaven).

8.13.1 The congregation sings the Lord's Prayer hymn

In the Braunschweig villages the sexton and people sang Luther's "Our Father" after the epistle, and the pastor sang the Lord's Prayer and the Verba before the communion (§8.3.3). In Schwarzburg the people sang the Lord's Prayer themselves where there were no scholars. **Schwarzburg and Stolberg, *Ordenunge der religion*, 1549** (Sehling 2, p. 130):

Where there are no scholars, the people may themselves sing the Our Father; thereafter the communion of the people taketh place, etc. The people may sing "God be praised and blessed," or other fair songs.

At weekday communions in Riga the whole assembly sang the Lord's Prayer hymn, so that the schoolboys were not kept from their lessons. **Riga, *Kirchenordnung*, 1530** (Sehling 5, p. 17):

But on the working day, when communicants are present, one singeth before the sermon as is customary; but straightway after the sermon one beginneth the set song of the Our Father, that the whole assembly may sing it (that the boys in the school be not hindered in their learning). Thereupon the priest speaketh the words of blessing over the bread and over the wine.

Sayn, *Kirchenordnung*, 1590 (Sehling 19/1, p. 407):

Thereafter let the priest say or sing the Our Father and the words of the body and blood of Christ; or the church may sing the Our Father in German together.

8.13.2 A communion hymn split around the consecration

A Henneberg village pastor began Hus's "Jesus Christus unser Heiland" (Jesus Christ our Saviour) before the Lord's Prayer and the Verba, and had the people finish it during the distribution. **Queienfeld (Henneberg), pastor's report, 1566** (Sehling 2, p. 344):

After the sermon, when there are communicants, we sing "Jesus Christ our Saviour," etc. Thereupon I sing or read the Our Father. Thereafter the words of consecration. Thereafter I communicate the people, and the people sing "Jesus Christ" out to the end, and "God be praised and blessed," etc.

In the Lutheran liturgy of Engerhafe the three stanzas of "O Lamm Gottes unschuldig" (O Lamb of God, innocent) were divided across the rite. The first came after the Verba, the second after the exhortation, and the third after the absolution, and with the third the communion began. **Engerhafe, *Liturgie*, 1583** (Sehling 7/1, pp. 678–680):

Let "O Lamb of God, innocent," etc. be sung the first time.

Let "O Lamb of God, innocent," etc. be sung the second time, and let the priest say: "Kneel down, beloved in the Lord, lift up your hearts to God, and let us pray devoutly."

Let "O Lamb of God, innocent," etc. be sung the third time, and let the communion be made with these words.

8.14 Under the communion (*sub communione*)

Hymns during the distribution are named more often than hymns in any other slot. The core never changed through the century:

- **"Jesus Christus unser Heiland, der von uns den Gotteszorn wandt" (Jesus Christ our Saviour, who turned from us the wrath of God)**, Luther's version of the Latin hymn ascribed to John Hus, and often called "John Hus's song";
- **"Gott sei gelobet und gebenedeiet" (God be praised and blessed)**, Luther's expansion of a medieval single stanza;
- **the German Sanctus**, "Jesaia dem Propheten" (To Isaiah the prophet);
- **Psalm 111** in German, "Ich danke dem Herrn von ganzem Herzen" (I thank the Lord with all my heart; Luther's *Confitebor* [I will give thanks]);
- **the Agnus Dei**, Latin or German ("O Lamm Gottes unschuldig", "Christe, du Lamm Gottes").

Around this core stood hymns added "when there are many communicants". These were the Latin responsory *Discubuit Jesus* (Jesus sat at table), *O sacrum convivium* (O sacred banquet), *Pange lingua* (Sing, my tongue; in Latin and German, "Mein Zung erkling" [Sound forth, my tongue]), "Als Jesus Christus unser Herr" (When Jesus Christ our Lord; Sebald Heyden), "Nun freut euch" (Now rejoice), "Was kann uns kommen an für Not" (What distress can come upon us), "O Christ, wir danken deiner Güt" (O Christ, we thank thy goodness), "Help Gott, dass mir's gelinge" (Help, God, that I may succeed), a Passion hymn in Lent, the festal hymns at the feasts, and the German Te Deum.

8.14.1 The core pair

Prussia, *Artikel der Ceremonien*, 1525 (Sehling 4, p. 33):

During such communicating the people with the choir shall sing the German song "Jesus Christ our Saviour," and after the communion "God be praised," etc.

Eisfeld, *Verordnung der Visitatoren*, 1554 (Sehling 1, p. 562):

During the communion the song of John Hus shall be sung, "Jesus Christ our Saviour," or "God be praised," or "Christ, thou Lamb of God."

A Henneberg pastor calls Hus's hymn "the instructive and comforting song of the holy martyr John Hus". **Herpf (Henneberg), *Kirchen-Ordnung*, 1566** (Sehling 2, p. 335):

During this and the most holy action the choir singeth the instructive and comforting song of the holy martyr John Hus, "Jesus Christ our Saviour," etc., and thereupon the thanksgiving, "God be praised."

Bremen in 1561 wanted Hus's hymn "in the ancient melody", that is, the Latin *Jesus Christus nostra salus* (Jesus Christ our salvation), "and at times also in the new one composed by Luther". This order was written against the Zwinglian party in Bremen, and it sets out the communion hymns in order. **Bremen, *Kirchenordnung*, 1561** (Sehling 7/2.2, p. 510):

It pleaseth us therefore that the text of Isaiah be sung, by turns in Latin or German. Let there follow it, during the communicating, the song of John Hus in the ancient melody, and at times also in the new one composed by Luther. Let there be

added also the hundred and eleventh psalm together with the Agnus Dei, if the multitude of communicants be great. And at length let it be concluded with the thanksgiving "God be praised," etc.

8.14.2 As many hymns as there are communicants

Nearly every order measures the number of communion hymns by the number of communicants. **Saxony (Albertine), *Kirchenordnung*, 1580** (Sehling 1, p. 369):

During the communion, and when the communicants are many, the Agnus Dei in Latin, together with the German songs, as "Isaiah the prophet, it befell," item the hundred and eleventh psalm, "I thank the Lord with all my heart," or "Jesus Christ our Saviour," item "God be praised," etc., one or more, shall be sung.

Henneberg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1582 (Sehling 2, p. 309):

During the communion shall be sung "Jesus Christ our Saviour," item "God be praised," or "Isaiah the prophet, it befell," or what else there may be of spiritual songs which are agreeable and fitting to this action and which the need requireth according to the number of communicants. But when the communicants are so few that even one of the aforesaid songs were too long, then it shall be stopped as soon as the communion is ended.

At the Dresden Kreuzkirche all the listed hymns were sung if there were many communicants. **Dresden, *Gottesdienst-Ordnung der Kreuzkirche*, 1574** (Sehling 1, p. 555):

During the communion is sung either the Agnus Dei, the Sanctus, "God be praised and blessed," "Jesus Christ our Saviour," "My tongue, resound." If the communicants are many, all these songs are sung.

The Lippe order puts the Agnus Dei, "O Lamm Gottes" (O Lamb of God) and "O Christ, wir danken deiner Güt" (O Christ, we thank thy goodness) on the high feasts, and ends with a hymn of thanks. **Lippe, *Kirchenordnung*, 1571** (Sehling 21, p. 388):

During the communion, while the sacrament is dispensed and distributed, the church shall sing one or more of the songs hereafter set, according as the communicants are many or few, as: "Jesus Christ our Saviour"; on the high feast days, the Agnus Dei, "O Lamb of God, innocent," "O Christ, we thank thee for thy goodness." After the communion the collect shall be sung by the preacher, thereupon the accustomed blessing or benediction (Numbers 6) spoken toward the people, and at the last it shall be concluded by the whole church with a song of thanks, as "God be praised," or "Praise and honour with high price."

Regensburg first sang the Latin Agnus Dei three times, slowly. If that was not long enough, a Latin thanksgiving from the gradual followed. **Regensburg, *Wahrhaftiger Bericht*, 1542** (Sehling 13, p. 393):

During this feeding of the people the schoolmaster singeth the Agnus Dei three times slowly. But where the communicants are so many that the three Agnus Deis will not reach until all have been served, then a Latin thanksgiving is sung thereto, as the most fitting can be found in the gradual.

Hof lists what was to be added "for the multitude of communicants". Hof's sequences in Latin and German come first, then *Discubuit*, then four German hymns, and then, if still needed, the short hymns otherwise sung after the sermon. **Hof, *Ordo ecclesiasticus*, 1592** (Sehling 11, p. 426):

These not sufficing because of the multitude of communicants, let German songs be added in the same manner as regards organ and choirs. Note: item the known sequences, composed in the Latin and German tongues, for the chief feasts. Moreover the responsory *Discubuit Jesus* (Jesus sat at table), in the second part of the Latin missal. 1. "Jesus Christ our Saviour," John Hus's. 2. "I thank the Lord with all my heart." 3. "Have mercy on me, O Lord God." 4. "May God be gracious unto us." All according to the number and multitude of the communicants, so that the following little songs also (which are otherwise sung on Sunday, and likewise Wednesday and Friday, after the sermon is ended) [may be] hung on at the end of the communion.

Wittenberg lists hymns "until the communion is over", including festal hymns. **Wittenberg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1533** (Sehling 1, p. 705):

While the people communicate, one singeth the Sanctus; the Agnus Dei; "Jesus Christ our Saviour"; "God be praised"; the German *Confitebor tibi* (I will give thanks unto thee); *Pange lingua* (Sing, my tongue) in Latin, and the like; also German songs of the feast, etc., until the communion is over.

8.14.3 The song stops when the communion ends

Bugenhagen's orders stop the hymn at the end of the distribution, even in mid-hymn, and go straight to the German Agnus Dei. **Pomerania, *Kirchenordnung*, 1535** (Sehling 4, p. 341):

While the communion lasteth, the church shall sing an Agnus Dei in Latin or German, "O Lamb of God," etc., "Jesus Christ," etc., "God be praised," etc., the psalm *Confitebor* (I will give thanks); but no longer than the communion lasteth. When the people have gone to the sacrament, another German Agnus Dei is sung, "Christ, thou Lamb of God," etc.

The appendix of the same order is sharper still: "all other singing shall then straightway cease, notwithstanding that a song begun be not sung out with all its verses" (Sehling 4, p. 344):

The German Agnus Dei: as soon as the people have communicated, all other singing shall then straightway cease, notwithstanding that a song begun be not sung out with all its verses: "Christ, thou Lamb of God, that bearest the sin of the world, have mercy upon us."

Mecklenburg, *Ordeninge der misse*, 1545 (Sehling 5, p. 155):

One shall also not sing longer than the communion lasteth; when that is out, the singing also shall cease. And then forthwith in the towns and villages one shall begin "O Lamb of God, innocent," three times, or "Christ, thou Lamb of God."

Schleswig-Holstein, *Kirchenordnung*, 1542 (Sehling 23, p. 91):

Then the schoolmaster beginneth forthwith "Jesus Christ our Saviour," etc., or something else that is like it. When the communion is out, the singing also ceaseth.

Hamburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1556 (Sehling 5, p. 553):

When now the communicants go to the altar, the songs of the sacrament shall be sung, "Jesus Christ," etc., "God be praised," etc., or, according to the occasion of the feasts, else a good song; yet so that the organist play always in between, and that the choir nevertheless sing all the verses. On the feasts, when there are many communicants, and also otherwise on the Sundays, one shall sing more: the Agnus Dei in Latin, at times also in German, "Christ, thou Lamb of God," etc. When now the communion hath taken place, the choir shall cease singing.

In the Kurpfalz order the minister could stop the singing if the service ran too long. **Kurpfalz, *Kirchenordnung*, 1556** (Sehling 14, p. 165):

Unless it were that, by reason of the number of communicants or other such chance causes, the action would grow somewhat too long; then the minister may command the singing to be broken off.

8.14.4 Stanzas between the actions

In the earliest Low German Mass from Schleswig-Holstein the choir sang one stanza of "Jesus Christus unser Heiland" (Jesus Christ our Saviour) after the consecration of the bread, the next during the distribution of the bread, and then fell silent until the cup. **Schleswig-Holstein, *Deutsche Messe* [after 1526]** (Sehling 23, pp. 56–57):

Now the choir beginneth to sing "Jesus Christ our Saviour," one verse thereof. Thereafter the priest turneth himself with the body of Christ to the people.

And [the choir] singeth so long until the body of Christ is distributed. Thereafter the choir keepeth still, and the priest beginneth further to consecrate the blood of Christ.

Bugenhagen's Hamburg order has the same pattern for bread and cup: the song stops when the communicants have received the bread, and after the cup the rest of the hymn is sung, or more is begun. **Hamburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1529** (Sehling 5, p. 529):

Meanwhile the people sing "Jesus Christ," etc., or "God be praised and blessed," etc. But when the communicants have come forward, the singing shall cease, and the priest shall take the cup and set forth the command of Christ further.

8.14.5 The Latin pieces and the German hymns beside them

Brandenburg began with the Latin *Discubuit Jesus* (Jesus sat at table) and added German hymns if there were many communicants. One German hymn was to be sung after the communion in any case. **Brandenburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1540** (Sehling 3, p. 70):

Thereupon the responsory *Discubuit Jesus* shall be begun in Latin; and if the communicants were many, so that it would not reach, one shall begin to sing German to the people, "God be praised," or "Jesus Christ our Saviour"; one of which songs, even though the *Discubuit* should suffice, shall nevertheless be sung after the communion.

Kurpfalz, provisional *Kirchenordnung*, 1546 (Sehling 14, p. 97):

During the communion the people sing the song "Jesus Christ our Saviour," or "God be praised," or else a Christian German psalm; or the choir also the responsory *Discubuit Jesus cum discipulis suis* (Jesus sat at table with his disciples), or the German *Pange lingua* (Sing, my tongue). After the communion the choir singeth the Agnus Dei.

Bremen, *Kirchenordnung*, 1534 (Sehling 7/2.2, p. 460):

Thereafter the communicants come forward, first the men, thereafter the women. In the meantime the schoolmaster singeth *O sacrum convivium* (O sacred banquet) and "Jesus Christ our Saviour," or the Sanctus and Agnus Dei.

At Heilbronn the Latin and German *Pange lingua* were sung in alternation with "Gott sei gelobet" (God be praised). **Heilbronn, *Kirchenordnung*, 1530** (Sehling 17/1, pp. 285–286):

Therefore one singeth the hymn *Pange lingua*, Latin and German, with the song of praise "God be praised and blessed," etc.

The Heilbronn song order of 1543 turns to the German and Latin Te Deum at great communions. **Heilbronn, *Ordnung des Kirchengesangs*, 1543** (Sehling 17/1, p. 323):

During the Supper, the Sanctus or Agnus Dei (Latin), or *Pange lingua* (Latin and German), with the organ. On high feasts, or with many communicants, the *Te Deum laudamus* (We praise thee, O God) in German and Latin with the organ (one verse after the other). Conclusion: *Grates nunc omnes* (Let us all now give thanks) on the organ.

8.14.6 Other hymns in the slot

Bugenhagen allowed "often" other hymns: "Nun freut euch" (Now rejoice), the baptism hymn, and German hymns of the feasts. **Wolfenbüttel, *Kirchenordnung*, 1543** (Sehling 6/1, p. 57):

Meanwhile the people sing "Jesus Christ our Saviour," etc., or "God be praised and blessed," etc., or the psalm *Confitebor* (I will give thanks) in German, etc. One may at times, and well often, sing also other songs under the communion, as "Now rejoice," etc., item the one of baptism, etc., and good songs, psalms and hymns in German of the feasts.

Rostock, *Conformitas ceremoniarum*, c. 1560 (Sehling 5, p. 288):

thereupon the organist shall play and the church sing "Jesus Christ our Saviour," and thereto, when the communicants are many, "God be praised" and "Help, God, that I may succeed."

Engerhafe, *Liturgie*, 1583 (Sehling 7/1, p. 681):

But during the communion let there be sung either "What need can come upon us," or "O Christ, we thank thee for thy goodness," or "Jesus Christ our Saviour," or "Now rejoice, dear Christians all," and other songs of that kind; or let the organ be played.

At Ortenburg "at times also the Passion" was sung, according as the communicants were many or few. **Ortenburg, 1563** (Sehling 13, p. 532):

But during such distribution the choir hath sung "Jesus Christ our Lord," or "Jesus Christ our Saviour," at times also the Passion, according as the communicants have been many or few.

Limpurg changed the communion hymn by season: the Passion in Lent and "Christ lag in Todesbanden" (Christ lay in death's bonds) on Easter Day. **Limpurg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1610** (Sehling 16, p. 620):

During the communion let the schoolmaster sing either Hus's song, "Jesus Christ our Saviour," etc., or "Now rejoice, dear Christians all"; item "God be praised and blessed." In Lent the Passion; on Easter Day, "Christ lay in the bands of death."

At Strasbourg Psalm 51 was sung at "great communions". **Strasbourg, *Gottesdienstordnung*, 1577** (Sehling 20/1, p. 516):

During the communion one singeth either "Jesus Christ our Saviour," John Hus's song, or "God be praised and blessed," or, when there are great communions, "O Lord God, be gracious unto me," or else a song of the season.

In the village order of Veit Dietrich's Nürnberg *Agendbüchlein* (agenda booklet), Sebald Heyden's "Als Jesus Christus unser Herr" (When Jesus Christ our Lord) was the first choice, with the shorter hymns "if that be too long". **Nürnberg, Veit Dietrich, *Agendbüchlein*, 1545** (Sehling 11, p. 502):

Meanwhile the church shall sing the song "When Jesus Christ our Lord," or, where that is too long, "God be praised," or "Jesus Christ our Saviour."

The Kassel general synod of 1607, as Hesse turned Reformed, kept "Gott sei gelobet" (God be praised). Beside it stood Lobwasser's Psalms 23, 103 and 111, "according to the occasion and number of the communicants". **Hessen-Kassel, *Abschied der Kasseler Generalsynode*, 1607** (Reformed; Sehling 9, p. 75):

and when the Lord's Supper is held, during the communion the song "God be praised and blessed," etc., or else, as out of Lobwasser, the twenty-third, hundred and third, hundred and eleventh psalm, according to the occasion and number of the communicants.

8.14.7 Choir, people and organ

Brenz wanted the choir in Latin and the church in German by turns, so that the communicants were admonished "not only inwardly but outwardly by the understandable song". **Schwäbisch Hall, *Kirchenordnung*, 1527** (Sehling 17/1, p. 51):

Herebetween the choir shall sing in Latin and the church in German by turns, that the receivers of the sacrament and others standing about may be admonished of their doing, not only inwardly, but outwardly through the understandable song.

Pomerania limited the organ during the communion, forbade worldly tunes on it, and had choir and people sing alternate verses so that the hymns would be learned by all. **Pomerania, *Agenda*, 1569** (Sehling 4, p. 439):

During the communion one singeth "Jesus Christ our Saviour," etc., or "God be praised," etc., or "O Lamb of God, innocent," etc., "Christ, thou Lamb of God," item "I thank the Lord with all my heart," etc., with the note that standeth in the German songbook, and the like German songs that rhyme with the communion. Item *Discubuit Jesus* (Jesus sat at table), item the Latin Agnus Dei, in plainsong, item *O sacrum convivium* (O sacred banquet), etc. When these songs are sung during the communion, the organists shall make their song with the organ the shorter, and play no worldly, light songs. The pastor shall see to it that the organs be so moderated that the German psalms during the communion be sung wholly to the end with the congregation, and that the aforesaid songs be sung by turns, the choir and the people one verse after another, that they may all alike become familiar to the scholars and the congregation.

Schönburg let the organ play during the communion only on high feasts. **Schönburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1542** (Sehling 2, p. 171):

During the communion one may sing by turns the German Sanctus, etc., as "Jesus Christ," at times the Latin Sanctus or Agnus Dei of the New Testament. The organist shall not play during the communion, unless on high feasts.

The organ's alternation with choir and people is treated in Chapter 9, §9.3.3.

8.14.8 How fixed the slot was

Fixed core, open margin. Every order opens the slot with Hus's hymn, "Gott sei gelobet" (God be praised), the German Sanctus or Psalm 111. What changed from service to service was not the choice but the quantity, measured by the number of communicants. The hymns added at the margin were festal hymns on feasts, the Passion in Lent, Latin chants where there was a school, and psalms of penitence or thanks.

8.15 The Agnus Dei, the thanksgiving, and the close

Two German Agnus Dei hymns were sung, during the communion (§8.14) or after it. One was Luther's "Christe, du Lamm Gottes" (Christ, thou Lamb of God; §8.15.1), the other Nikolaus Decius's "O Lamm Gottes unschuldig" (O Lamb of God, innocent). Both kept the threefold form of the Latin. Decius's hymn was one stanza sung three times. The third time it ended with the prayer for peace instead of the prayer for mercy, as the third Agnus Dei ends with *dona nobis pacem* (grant us peace) instead of *miserere nobis* (have mercy upon us). Neuenrade prints it so in Low German, after a plain German Agnus Dei with the same rubric. **Neuenrade, *Kirchenordnung*, 1564** (Sehling 22, p. 532):

Another Agnus: O Lamb of God, innocent, slain on the stem of the cross, at all times found patient, although thou wast despised. All sins hast thou borne, else must we have despaired. Have mercy upon us, O Jesu. The third time: Grant us peace, O Jesu.

The other orders that show the form give the same three singings:

- **Calenberg-Göttingen 1542** prints the one stanza with its notes. Sehling's editor notes that the order's Masses for the Passion, Easter, Ascension and Pentecost add "Give us thy peace, O Jesu!" (Sehling 6/2, p. 816, n. 52a; §7.13.3).
- **Mecklenburg 1545** has it begun "three times" when the communion ends (§8.14.3).
- **Engerhafe 1583** sings it the first, the second and the third time at three points of the rite (§8.13.2).
- **Hof 1592** has it sung "three times, the last time with these words added: Give us thy peace, O Jesu" (Sehling 11, pp. 426, 429). On Maundy Thursday and Good Friday Hof divides it about a baptism, "the first stanza before one beginneth to baptize, and then after the baptism the other two stanzas" (Sehling 11, p. 431).

The longer form is not found. No order uses the longer five-stanza version of the hymn, which is not in the corpus and is cited here only to tell the two forms apart. It keeps Decius's stanza first, but the other four stanzas are new:

- two on the Passion, "O Lamm Gottes im Staube, / Mit Blut und Thränen bedecket" (O Lamb of God in the dust, covered with blood and tears) and "O Lamm Gottes, unschuldig, / Trugst du die herbe Verhöhnung" (O Lamb of God, innocent, thou didst bear the bitter mockery);
- one of thanks and repentance, "Von Herzen wir dir danken" (From our hearts we thank thee);
- one of trust at the last hour, "Stärk in uns das Vertrauen" (Strengthen in us the trust), which closes the hymn with the prayer for peace, "Give us thy peace, O Jesu".

Only the first and fourth stanzas end "Have mercy upon us, O Jesu", so the stanzas no longer follow the three petitions of the Latin. None of the lines of the four new stanzas occurs in the corpus, and no order sings the hymn more than three times or counts more than three stanzas. Most orders name the hymn by its first line only and do not show the form. Those that show it give the short one.

8.15.1 "Christe, du Lamm Gottes" after the communion

In Bugenhagen's orders, and in those that followed them, the German Agnus Dei "Christe, du Lamm Gottes" (Christ, thou Lamb of God) was sung after all had communicated. It was sung three times, the third time ending "gib uns deinen Frieden" (give us thy peace). It served as the people's thanksgiving, addressed to Christ in heaven. **Hamburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1529** (Sehling 5, p. 529):

But when they have all communicated and are in their places, they and all the people sing to Christ in heaven the German Agnus Dei three times, thus: "Christ, thou Lamb of God, that bearest the sin of the world, have mercy upon us"; the third time, "give us thy peace. Amen."

The Braunschweig order of 1528 has the same rubric (Sehling 6/1, p. 442). The Albertine order lets any of the German communion hymns be closed with "Christe, du Lamm Gottes". **Saxony (Albertine), *Kirchenordnung*, 1539**, variants A and B (Sehling 1, p. 275):

when one or more of the German songs have been sung (as "Jesus Christ our Saviour," etc., item the German Sanctus, "Isaiah the prophet, it befell," item the psalm "I thank the Lord with all my heart," etc.), one may conclude with the German Agnus Dei following: [the notes follow to "Christ, thou Lamb of God, that bearest the sin of the world, have mercy upon us. Grant us thy peace."]

Mecklenburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1552 (Sehling 5, p. 199):

During the communion let "Jesus Christ our Saviour" be sung; item "God be praised," the Agnus Dei, "Isaiah the prophet." And when the communicants are many, let the hundred and eleventh psalm be sung, "I thank the Lord with all my heart," as it standeth in the German songbook; likewise other German spiritual songs. And at the close, "Christ, thou Lamb of God."

At Suhl the boys sang songs of the season or of the sacrament during the communion, "and it is commonly concluded with the song *Christe du Lamm Gottes*". **Suhl, *Ordnung des predigamts*, 1562** (Sehling 2, p. 351):

The communion, during which the boys sing [songs] of the season or of the sacrament; and it is commonly concluded with the song "Christ, thou Lamb of God."

Neuenrade has "Agnus Dei in German" as the communicants go to the altar and "Gott sei gelobet" (God be praised) after. **Neuenrade, *Kirchenordnung*, 1564** (Sehling 22, p. 519):

Then one singeth the Agnus Dei in German, and the communicants go to the altar. After the Agnus Dei one singeth "God be praised," etc.

8.15.2 "Gott sei gelobet" as the thanksgiving

Luther's *Formula missae* (Form of the Mass) already wanted "Gott sei gelobet" (God be praised) sung after the communion. He dropped the stanza about receiving the sacrament at the hour of death "from the hands of the consecrated priest". **Wittenberg, Luther, *Formula missae*, 1523** (Sehling 1, p. 9):

Meanwhile it pleaseth [me] that this be sung after the communion: "God be praised and blessed, who himself hath fed us," etc.; that little part being left out, "And the holy sacrament at our last end, out of the consecrated priest's hands."

The Albertine order ends the service with it: "and therewith go home" (Sehling 1, p. 275):

Then the people may be let sing the song "God be praised and blessed," and therewith go home.

Rothenberg, *Vereinigung*, 1618 (Sehling 13, p. 550):

During the same let psalms and songs be sung that belong thereto. After the communion is ended let "God be praised and blessed," etc. be sung for thanksgiving for the same.

8.15.3 The closing hymn

The last hymn of the service was one of a small group: "Gott sei gelobet" (God be praised), "Dank sagen wir alle" (Let us all give thanks to God), "Sei Lob und Ehr mit hohem Preis" (Praise and honour be with high praise; the last stanza of "Es ist das Heil" [Salvation has come to us]), "Erhalt uns" (Keep us) with "Verleih uns Frieden" (Grant us peace), *Da pacem* (Give peace), "Es woll uns Gott genädig sein" (May God be gracious to us), or a festal hymn. Where the Mass ended with the *Benedicamus*, in Latin or German, these hymns followed it or, in some orders, stood in its place (§§8.16.8–8.16.9). Tecklenburg closes with thanksgiving. **Tecklenburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1543** (Sehling 22, p. 244):

At the last the people shall praise the Lord and thank him with all their heart with the song "Thanks say we all," etc., "In peace and [joy," or the like German thanksgiving].

Northeim closes with the prayer for peace, because "for temporal peace we are bound to pray at all times". **Northeim, *Kirchenordnung*, 1539** (Sehling 6/2, p. 926):

We also think good that for the final close the song *Da pacem, Domine* (Give peace, O Lord) be sung in the Latin or German tongue by the boys and schoolmaster. For we are bound at all times to pray for temporal peace.

In Mecklenburg priest, communicants and congregation knelt for "Erhalt uns" and "Verleih uns Frieden". **Mecklenburg, *Ordeninge der misse*, 1545** (Sehling 5, p. 155):

And then the priest shall set himself upon his knees before the altar. The whole congregation shall also do so, and begin "Keep us, Lord, by thy word," the three verses, and then "Grant us peace graciously, Lord God," etc.

Buxtehude closed with *Da pacem* or "Verleih uns Frieden", sung without the organ, or "a psalm fitting the present need", such as "Mitten wir im Leben sind" (In the midst of life we are). **Buxtehude, *Kirchenordnung*, 1552** (Sehling 7/1, p. 76):

At the close the choir alone, without the organ, shall sing *Da pacem*, or in German "Grant us peace," or else a psalm fitting thereto according to the present need, as "In the midst of life we are," or others like it.

Hamburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1556 (Sehling 5, p. 553):

At the last the choir shall sing *Da pacem*, etc., or in German "Grant us peace," etc.; but on special feasts another song that will fit thereto.

Hoya gives the festal closing hymns. **Hoya, *Kirchenordnung*, 1581** (Sehling 6/2, p. 1150):

Thereafter one singeth "May God be gracious unto us," etc. But on the feasts one singeth what the feasts bring with them, as at Christmas "Praised be thou, Jesu Christ," with the verses following; at Easter the short "Jesus Christ our Saviour, who overcame death"; at Pentecost "Come, Holy Ghost, Lord God," etc.

Pomerania, *Agenda*, 1569 (Sehling 4, p. 439):

At the close is sung "Praise and honour," etc., or "Keep us, Lord," etc., "Grant us peace," etc., "O God, we thank thee for thy goodness," etc., and the like.

Hildesheim (Stift), *Kirchenordnung für Steuerwald und Peine*, 1561 (Sehling 7/2.1, p. 783):

when that is done, the sexton with the people singeth at the last, to the end: "Praise and honour with high price."

In the Braunschweig villages two closing hymns alternated, one holy day after the other (Sehling 6/1, p. 473):

And at the close the sexton shall sing with the people, one holy day after the other, "May God be gracious unto us" and "Keep us, Lord, by thy word."

8.15.4 The closing hymn covers the priest's devesting

In the Hildesheim city order the closing hymn was sung while the celebrant took off his vestment and knelt again at the altar to give thanks privately. **Hildesheim (city), *Kirchenordnung*, 1544** (Sehling 7/2.1, p. 855):

Then the schoolmaster beginneth a German short psalm, or what pleaseth him, and therewith an end, etc. But while the song lasteth, the preacher undresseth himself and layeth the Mass vestment together, kneeleth down again before the altar, and thanketh God secretly for himself.

8.15.5 A custom found and left alone

A Henneberg pastor found "Verleih uns Frieden" (Grant us peace) sung at the very end in his parish. He left it, since it could not be faulted. **Wasungen (Henneberg), pastor's report, 1566** (Sehling 2, p. 356):

When now the communion is done, one concludeth with the collect and the blessing. "Grant us peace," with the collect appended, I have found here thus: that it was sung at the very end and therewith concluded; which, since it is not to be blamed, I also would not change.

8.15.6 How fixed the slots were

Fixed, with a handful of choices and festal exchange. The post-communion Agnus was "Christe, du Lamm Gottes" (Christ, thou Lamb of God) or "O Lamm Gottes" (O Lamb of God). The thanksgiving was "Gott sei gelobet" (God be praised), "Dank sagen wir alle" (Let us all give thanks to God) or "Sei Lob und Ehr" (Praise and honour be to the highest good). The close was the prayer for peace and the word ("Verleih uns Frieden", *Da pacem*, "Erhalt uns"), or Psalm 67. At the high feasts the festal hymn of the day took the closing slot.

8.16 Vespers, matins, the catechism and the weekday services

8.16.1 Office hymns: only of the season, and only if pure

The Latin office hymn (*hymnus*) of matins and vespers stayed where there was a school. The rule was that it be "of the season" and "pure". Hymns to the saints were dropped, and single stanzas that invoked the saints or the cross were cut. **Transylvanian Saxons, *Kirchenordnung*, 1547** (Sehling 24, p. 224, Latin; p. 245, German):

We admit no hymns save those of the season.

The hymns also are kept according to the season, and no others.

Schleswig-Holstein warns against hymns that speak of the merit and invocation of the saints. It names the *O crux ave* stanza of *Vexilla regis*. **Schleswig-Holstein, *Kirchenordnung*, 1542** (Sehling 23, p. 143):

So also godliness and the Christian faith require that we beware of the hymns wherein is written of the merit and invocation of the saints. For who would hereafter lift up a wooden cross and sing the godless song, *O Crux, ave spes unica*, etc.?

The Ansbach chapter order of 1533 made the same cut. **Brandenburg-Ansbach, *Ordnung singens und lesens bei den Stiften*, 1533** (Sehling 11, p. 316):

On Passion Sunday: in the hymn *Vexilla Regis* the verse *O crux, ave spes* shall be left out.

The Heilbronn song order of 1543 cuts the Marian stanza of the Candlemas hymn. **Heilbronn, *Ordnung des Kirchengesangs*, 1543** (Sehling 17/1, p. 322):

Candlemas: hymn *Quod chorus vatum* (What the choir of prophets; before *Tu libens votis* [Thou, gladly to our vows], which is to be left out).

At Hof the hymns of John the Baptist and the apostles were sung in the text "corrected in Lossius". **Hof, *Ordo ecclesiasticus*, 1592** (Sehling 11, p. 423):

Hymn: *Ut queant laxis* (That with loosened [voices]; corrected in Lossius).

At Regensburg the vesper hymn of the season was sung "if it be not godless". **Regensburg, *Kirchenordnung* of Justus Jonas, 1553** (Sehling 13, p. 419):

and straightway thereupon both choirs [sing] the hymn of the season, if it be not godless.

8.16.2 One hymn for a whole season

The office hymn changed by season, not by day. Hof kept the German Te Deum at vespers from Michaelmas to Advent. **Hof, *Ordo ecclesiasticus*, 1592** (Sehling 11, p. 447):

At vespers. Hymn: "Lord God, we praise thee." N.B.: This hymn is kept until the Advent of Christ.

Heilbronn kept *O lux beata Trinitas* from Trinity to Advent. **Heilbronn, *Ordnung des Kirchengesangs*, 1543** (Sehling 17/1, p. 321):

Trinity until Advent: with the customary Christian antiphons the hymn *O lux beata Trinitas* is to be sung.

The Henneberg afternoon service opened with a seasonal hymn, played on the organ, then sung in figured music, and then followed by the German Magnificat of the whole congregation. **Henneberg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1582** (Sehling 2, p. 310):

and then on the high feasts, as Christmas, the German *Grates nunc omnes* (Let us all now give thanks) and "Praised be thou, Jesu Christ," until about the Purification; from the Sunday after the Purification, the German *Nunc dimittis*, until Lent; through Lent until Easter, "Christ, who art the day and light"; from Easter until Ascension Day, "So holy is the day," or "Christ is arisen," or "Christ lay in the bands of death"; from Ascension Day until Pentecost, "Christ went up to heaven"; from Pentecost, [a song] of the Holy Ghost until Advent; in Advent until Christmas, "Now come, the Saviour of the heathen": all Sundays in the afternoon played upon the organ, where there is one, and thereupon the same straightway sung in figured music; then the Magnificat [shall be] sung by the cantor and choir with the whole congregation.

In the Pomeranian *Agenda* vespers opened, kneeling, with *Veni sancte Spiritus* (Come, Holy Spirit) or a Latin song of the season "for the entrance or the going out". The schoolmaster chose it with the pastor. **Pomerania, *Agenda*, 1569** (Sehling 4, p. 435):

First one singeth on bended knees *Veni sancte Spiritus*, or the first verse *Veni creator Spiritus* (Come, Creator Spirit), or *Adesto Deus unus* (Be present, O one God), etc., or what else is fitting for the season: as in Advent, *Veni Domine visitare nos in pace* (Come, O Lord, to visit us in peace), etc.; about Christmas, *Puer natus in Bethlehem* (A child is born in Bethlehem), *In dulci jubilo* (In sweet rejoicing), *Resonet in laudibus* (Let it resound in praises), *Nunc angelorum gloria* (Now the glory of the angels); about Easter, *Surrexit Christus hodie* (Christ is risen today); about Pentecost, *Spiritus sancti gratia*, *Veni maxime Spiritus*, etc.: as the schoolmaster or cantor, with the counsel of the pastor, shall think good what is serviceable for the entrance or the going out.

8.16.3 Latin for the school, German for the people

Bugenhagen kept the Latin office for the school, and moved the German hymns to the times when the laity were present. **Hamburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1529** (Sehling 5, p. 524):

Such Latin songs will not hinder the laity in their German songs, for they will be sung when the laity have nothing to do in the church with hearing preaching. They will get enough to sing in German otherwise. For before all sermons and after all sermons they shall [sing in German].

Braunschweig, *Kirchenordnung*, 1528 (Sehling 6/1, p. 442):

German hymns in Advent, at Christmas until the Purification, at Easter until Pentecost, at Pentecost, of the feasts, or else other hymns, may well be sung on the holy day at vespers, when the laity are there.

Hildesheim (city), *Kirchenordnung*, 1544 (Sehling 7/2.1, p. 856):

At the other sermons it is enough that we sing a psalm before and a psalm or song after in German. But when our school children come alone to the church, to sing and to read what is ordained, no one shall hinder them from reading and singing in Latin.

8.16.4 The German Te Deum sung verse by verse

The German canticles — the Te Deum, Magnificat, Benedictus and Nunc dimittis — were the congregational pieces of the offices. The Te Deum was sung by alternating halves, the choir one verse and the people the next. At Wittenberg a school usher stood in a stall in the middle of the church to lead the people "until the people grow used to it". **Wittenberg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1533** (Sehling 1, p. 705):

and a school usher shall, in the scholars' stall in the midst of the church, answer every half verse with the people, as it is made. He may also at first take some boys into the stall to help, until the people grow used to singing along such Te Deum.

Northeim, *Kirchenordnung*, 1539 (Sehling 6/2, p. 924):

And although the Latin tongue shall by no means be let go out of the church, yet it is thought good that the Te Deum be sung in German on the Sundays and holy days, that the congregation too be not in the church in vain; yet so that the choir sing one verse, the whole church the other.

At Calenberg the sexton came out of the choir to lead the congregation's half. **Calenberg- Göttingen, *Kirchenordnung*, 1542** (Sehling 6/2, p. 792):

After the responsory the *Te Deum laudamus* (We praise thee, O God) in German, so that the choir sing one verse, the congregation outside the other. But especially here the sexton must step out of the choir and govern the congregation, that it sing finely in order.

8.16.5 The evening *Salve* replaced

The late-medieval evening devotion of the *Salve Regina* was abolished, or turned to Christ. **Plauen, *Ordnung der Ceremonien*, 1529** (Sehling 2, p. 111):

In the evening at five or six o'clock the boys sing every day the *Salve Jesu Christe* with the *Da pacem* (Give peace) in Latin and a German collect.

At Heilbronn a German hymn took the place of the *Salve* as an evening blessing. **Heilbronn, draft *Gottesdienstordnung*, 1532** (Sehling 17/1, p. 302):

At night, at *Salve* time: that in the stead of the former *Salve*, for a blessing before sleep, the schoolmaster with his boys sing a German song of praise, as the litany, or "In the midst of life we are," or *Da pacem Domine* (Give peace, O Lord), and the like, and conclude with a collect.

The Hohenlohe order of 1553 abolished the *Salve Regina* outright, "because it is flat against God's word and the honour of Christ" (Sehling 15, p. 74):

Of the *Salve*. The *Salve regina coeli*, etc., which hath hitherto been sung, because it is flat against God's word and the honour of Christ, shall be wholly done away.

In the Kraichgau order of Neckarbischofsheim it stayed, "turned upon Christ and put into German". **Neckarbischofsheim, *Kirchenordnung*, 1560** (Sehling 16, p. 672):

thereupon the schoolmaster singeth the Magnificat in German, Luke 1. Thereupon followeth the *Salve Regina coeli*, turned upon Christ and put into German.

8.16.6 The catechism service: the hymn of the chief part

The catechism service chose its hymn by the chief part being taught. This is the clearest case in the corpus of a hymn chosen by its doctrine, and it is nearly universal:

Chief part	Hymn
Ten Commandments	"Dies sind die heilgen zehn Gebot" (These are the holy ten commandments); "Mensch, willst du leben seliglich" (Man, wouldst thou live blessedly)
Creed	"Wir glauben all" (We all believe); "Ich glaub an Gott" (I believe in God)
Lord's Prayer	"Vater unser im Himmelreich" (Our Father in the kingdom of heaven)
Baptism	"Christ unser Herr zum Jordan kam" (Christ our Lord came to the Jordan)
Lord's Supper	"Jesus Christus unser Heiland" (Jesus Christ our Saviour); "Gott sei gelobet" (God be praised)
Keys / Confession	"Aus tiefer Not" (Out of deep distress); "Erbarm dich mein" (Have mercy on me, O Lord God); "So wahr ich leb" (As truly as I live, saith God the Lord)

Lippe, *Kirchenordnung*, 1571 (Sehling 21, p. 386):

Thereupon let the church also sing a Christian German psalm agreeable to the article of the catechism then treated: as at the exposition of the Decalogue, "The Ten Commandments," item "Man, wilt thou live blessedly," etc.; of the creed, "The Creed" and other psalms serving thereto; of the Our Father, "Our Father, who art in heaven, as Jesus Christ teacheth us," item "Our Father in the kingdom of heaven"; of holy baptism, "Through Adam's fall," and "Christ our Lord to Jordan came," etc.; of the most worthy sacrament of the altar, "What need can come upon us," item "Jesus Christ our Saviour": that the songs, wherein the holy divine Scripture is summed up in fair round words, may become known and common to the unlearned and young folk.

Grubenhagen kept the same hymn for as long as the one chief part was being taught. **Grubenhagen, *Kirchenordnung*, 1581** (Sehling 6/2, p. 1046):

Herewith one can also always sing something that rhymeth with the part of the catechism that hath been expounded: as when the Ten Commandments are expounded, and as long as one is busied therewith, one can sing "These are the holy ten commandments," etc., or "Man, wilt thou live blessedly," etc.; and so forth with the others; that the young folk may grasp the Christian, spiritual songs, which often give them a good exposition and glorious light, and that they may cleave the deeper in memory and heart.

A Henneberg pastor did the same. **Queienfeld (Henneberg), pastor's report, 1566** (Sehling 2, pp. 344–345):

[We] sing first at the beginning the Ten Commandments, as long as the Ten Commandments are taught; and thereafter [the hymn] of the three chief articles of the creed, as long as that also is preached; and so forth to the end of the catechism.

In the Hoya villages the catechism service opened with Speratus's "Nun lasst uns Christen fröhlich sein" (Now let us Christians be joyful), and then took the hymn of each chief part. **Hoya, *Kirchenordnung*, 1581** (Sehling 6/2, p. 1150):

[they shall] begin to sing a psalm of the catechism, which is found in the psalm book and is called "Now let us Christians be joyful," etc. Thereafter, in the treating of the Decalogue, one singeth "These are the holy ten commandments"; in the treating of the creed, "We believe"; over the Our Father, "Our Father in the kingdom of heaven"; over the teaching of baptism, "Christ our Lord to Jordan came"; in the treating of the Supper, "Jesus Christ our Saviour"; and at times also other fine Lutheran psalms, that the people may learn to sing one psalm after another.

Hohenlohe opened the catechism "with a song of that chief part which the pastor has in hand to treat" (Sehling 15, p. 654):

The catechism also shall be begun with a song of that chief part which the pastor hath in hand to treat.

The Kurland order taught the Latvian peasants the catechism hymns first, one before and one after, "until the un-German people can learn and profit more". **Kurland, *Kirchenordnung*, 1570** (Sehling 5, p. 91):

But the pastors of the un-German [the Latvians] shall, before all other psalms, apply themselves to the order of the catechism and teach the people to sing: 1. The Ten Commandments, "These are the holy ten commandments." 2. The creed, "We all believe in one God." 3. The Our Father, "Our Father in the kingdom of heaven." 4. Baptism, "Christ our Lord to Jordan came." 5. The sacrament of the altar, "Jesus Christ our Saviour," "God be praised." 6. The Gloria, "To God alone on high be glory." These they shall first teach them to sing one after another, the one piece before, the other after, and bring them into use, until the un-German people may learn and profit more.

Wertheim calls "Nun freut euch" (Now rejoice) a good paraphrase of the whole creed. **Wertheim, *Kirchenordnung*, c. 1555** (Sehling 11, p. 716):

That the catechism also may be in practice, the Ten Commandments shall be sung before the sermon, namely in the fair paraphrase thereof. […] Also the song "Now rejoice, dear Christians all" doeth sufficient rehearsal of all the articles of faith, and is a good paraphrase upon the creed.

The catechism service itself, its hour, length and order, is treated in Chapter 10, §10.10.

8.16.7 Weekday services: reusing the Sunday hymn

At Hof, the Wednesday service repeated the hymn of the Sunday before. On Friday the German hymn of the Sunday vespers was sung again. **Hof, *Ordo ecclesiasticus*, 1592** (Sehling 11, p. 429):

II. On Wednesday the song of the preceding Sunday or feast is for the most part repeated by two choirs. On Friday the German hymn of the evening prayers of the preceding Sunday or feast is sung.

Regensburg sang a German psalm on weekdays "for the people's sake, that the people may learn the same and in time sing along". **Regensburg, *Kirchenordnung* of Hieronymus Noppus, 1543** (Sehling 13, p. 408):

That there first be sung a psalm or else a song in German, for the people's sake, that the people may learn the same and in time may sing along; whereto they shall at times be exhorted in the sermon.

In wartime Neuenstein held a daily prayer service at noon. After the prayer it sang one of seven psalm-hymns of trust and defence, in fixed order, "one each day, and no other". **Neuenstein, *Befehle wegen des Gebetsgottesdienstes*, 1588–1594** (Sehling 15, p. 540):

following that, changing about, always after the prayer [let] one of these psalms be sung after, namely: 1. "A mighty fortress is our God," etc.; 2. "Give peace in our time," etc.; 3. "Keep us, Lord, by thy word," etc., and "Grant us peace graciously," etc.; 4. "Where God the Lord standeth not by us," etc.; 5. "Were God not with us at this time," etc.; 6. "Ah God, from heaven look down," etc.; 7. "In thee have I hoped, Lord," etc.; and thereupon conclude with the blessing; so that every day in the whole week one after the other in the order set above be sung after the prayer, and no other.

The Hohenlohe *Gesangsordnung* of 1596 likewise rotated Lobwasser's Psalms 20, 61 and 79 on the Friday prayer days, the last "because of the present great need of the Turk", "one Friday after the other in order" (Sehling 15, pp. 655–656).

8.16.8 The *Benedicamus*: kept, graded and put into German

The versicle *Benedicamus Domino* (Let us bless the Lord), with its response *Deo gratias* or *Deo dicamus gratias* (Let us say thanks to God), ended matins and vespers. After Luther's *Formula missae* (Form of the Mass) it also ended the Mass. Some Lutheran sources outside the church orders sing a festal Latin song, such as *Puer natus in Bethlehem* (A child is born in Bethlehem), with the *Benedicamus* or in its stead: a troped or substituted *Benedicamus*. This pass searched the corpus for that practice in three ways:

- every mention of the *Benedicamus* (411 passages);
- the incipits of the medieval *Benedicamus* tropes;
- the incipits of the old festal songs: *Puer natus in Bethlehem*, *In dulci jubilo* (In sweet rejoicing), *Resonet in laudibus* (Let it resound in praises), *Nunc angelorum gloria* (Now the glory of the angels), *Dies est laetitiae* (It is a day of gladness), *Joseph lieber Joseph mein* (Joseph, dear Joseph mine), *Surrexit Christus hodie* (Christ is risen today).

The result is this:

- **No order in the corpus prescribes a troped *Benedicamus*.** No order names a *Benedicamus* trope. None puts a festal song inside the versicle, or between versicle and response.
- **The orders keep the *Benedicamus*, grade it by season and put it into German** (this section). **They also let a figured motet or a German hymn take its place** (§8.16.9).
- ***Puer natus in Bethlehem* and the other festal songs are found, but at other places.** They come after the Magnificat, just before the collect and *Benedicamus*; at the entrance or going out of festal vespers; for the introit; and after the catechism or the sermon (§8.16.10).

If the troped *Benedicamus* was sung in these churches, the orders do not record it. It may have lived in the cantionals that several orders impose (Lossius, Spangenberg; §8.18.6), which are not part of this corpus.

At the end of the Mass. Luther put the *Benedicamus* in the place of *Ite missa est* (Go, it is the dismissal). He allowed the alleluia to be added, and the melodies of the vesper *Benedicamus* to be borrowed. **Wittenberg, Luther, *Formula missae*, 1523** (Sehling 1, p. 6):

In the stead of *Ite missa* let there be said *Benedicamus Domino*, with alleluia added (where and when it pleaseth) in its own melodies. Or let the *Benedicamus* [melodies] be borrowed from those of vespers.

The first Nürnberg Mass ends "with the Benedicamus Domino, in the Sunday tone", followed by "Es woll uns Gott genädig sein" (May God be gracious to us; **Nürnberg, *Form und Ordnung einer christlichen Messe*, 1525**, Sehling 11, p. 57).

In German. Müntzer's Allstedt offices (Radical Reformation) end every matins with a German *Benedicamus*. It is plain in Advent and the Passion, with a threefold alleluia at Easter. **Allstedt, Thomas Müntzer, *Deutsch kirchenampt*, [1523]**, end of Easter matins (Radical Reformation; Sehling 1, p. 491):

The *Benedicamus*. […] Let us bless the Lord, alleluia, alleluia, alleluia. God be thanked for ever, alleluia, alleluia.

The Advent form is on p. 475 and the Passion form on p. 485. Müntzer's *Deutsch evangelisch messe* (German evangelical Mass) of 1524 (Radical Reformation) ends each Mass with the same words (Sehling 1, pp. 501–503), and so does the Erfurt *Deutsches Kirchenamt* (German church office) of 1525 (Sehling 2, pp. 376, 380). In Franconia the German form closed the Mass after the thanksgiving collect. **Brandenburg-Ansbach, *Auctuarium*, 1548** (Interim order; Sehling 11, p. 330):

After that the priest saith: "Let us bless the Lord!" The people answereth: "God be praised!" with the blessing following, as it is set down in the order.

Hof printed a melody for it. **Hof, *Ordo ecclesiasticus*, 1592** (Sehling 11, p. 426):

Then the deacon addeth the German *Benedicamus*, this melody being kept. […] "Let us bless the Lord." Choir: "God be thanked."

The Wolfenbüttel convents might close their hours "with the Benedicamus in German or Latin" (**Wolfenbüttel, *Kirchenordnung*, 1569**, Sehling 6/1, p. 261).

Graded by season. Like the Kyrie and the Sanctus (§§8.6, 8.12), the *Benedicamus* had its own melodies for the seasons and ranks. They were named after the Latin chants: *in adventu* (in Advent), *angelicum* (angelic [Kyrie]), *dominicale* (Sunday [Kyrie]), *paschale* (Easter [Kyrie]), *festivale*, *feriale*. Hof gives the fullest scheme, with notes, in its register of vespers. The rule comes first. **Hof, *Ordo ecclesiasticus*, 1592** (Sehling 11, p. 411):

IX. *Benedicamus Domino*, of the season, [sung by] two or three boys; *Deo dicamus gratias*, the whole choir, either in plainsong or in figured music.

The grades then follow:

- *in adventu* (p. 412);
- *angelicum* at Christmas (p. 412), which Sehling notes is the name of a melody;
- *dominicale* from Septuagesima to Easter (p. 414), and again from the fifth Sunday after Trinity (p. 420);
- two Easter forms with a threefold alleluia (p. 417);
- the Pentecost form with alleluia (p. 419);
- *festivale seu feriale* (festal or ferial; p. 422).

The Easter forms are these (Sehling 11, p. 417):

The first Easter *Benedicamus*: *Benedicamus Domino*, alleluia, alleluia, alleluia. *Deo dicamus gratias*. […] These are wont to be sung by turns.

The northern orders name the grade without the notes. Pomerania closes Sunday matins so. **Pomerania, *Agenda*, 1569** (Sehling 4, p. 437):

Thereupon the chaplain readeth a collect, and the choir singeth *Benedicamus Domino*, the Sunday [melody] or [that] of the season.

- At Lübeck two children sang the *benedicamus dominicale* after the collect (**Lübeck, *Kirchenordnung*, 1531**, Sehling 5, pp. 348, 351).
- At Lüneburg, when the thanksgiving day of 1575 fell on a Sunday, morning prayer ended with the *Benedicamus angelicum*. Sehling's note calls it especially elaborate (**Lüneburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1575**, Sehling 6/1, p. 663).

The long melodies rejected. Neuenrade printed the plain and the Easter forms. It dropped the long melismatic ones, for they had "few words and [little] devotion". **Neuenrade, *Kirchenordnung*, 1564** (Sehling 22, p. 540):

Benedicamus Domino. Deo dicamus gratias. Benedicamus Domino, alleluia, alleluia, alleluia. *Deo dicamus gratias*, alleluia, alleluia, alleluia. The *Benedicamus* with the many notes shall be let alone, for they make much crying, and have few words and [little] devotion.

The *Benedicamus* as the dismissal of the Mass is treated in Chapter 2, §2.13.1.

8.16.9 The *Benedicamus* replaced: motets and German hymns

Motets. Where figured music was sung, Hof let a motet stand in the place of the *Benedicamus*. **Hof, *Ordo ecclesiasticus*, 1592** (Sehling 11, p. 411):

N.B. In figured music, however, the evening prayers are concluded with some fitting motet (we call it a *mutet*) in the stead of the *Benedicamus*.

Hof's calendar of figured music for the chief feasts names the motets. The text of each belongs to the feast:

- the eve of Advent: *Jerusalem plantabis vineam* (Thou shalt plant a vineyard, Jerusalem; Lasso, for 5 voices) (p. 456);
- Christmas Eve: *Angelus ad pastores ait* (The angel said to the shepherds; Lasso, for 5) (p. 457);
- the eve of the Circumcision: *Postquam consummati sunt dies octo* (After eight days were accomplished; Joachim a Burck, for 5) (p. 458);
- the eve of the Epiphany: *Videntes stellam* (Seeing the star; Lasso, for 5) (p. 458);

- the eve of the Annunciation: *Speremus meliora omnes* (Let us all hope for better things; Wert, for 5) (p. 460);
- the eve of the Ascension: *Tempus est ut revertar* (It is time that I return; Lasso, for 6) (p. 462).

The plainsong *Benedicamus* of the grade stays as the alternative. Christmas Eve reads so (Sehling 11, p. 457):

Magnificat of the fifth tone, for 5, of Orlando. The *Benedicamus angelicum* noted below [not printed!], or in its stead: *Angelus ad pastores ait*, for 5, of Orlando.

German hymns in its place. Ostfriesland allowed a German psalm for the *Benedicamus* at both vespers and matins. **Ostfriesland, *Kirchenordnung*, 1535** (Sehling 7/1, p. 380):

And thereafter let one sing the Magnificat with a Christian antiphon out of godly Scripture, with a Christian collect, in Latin or in German; thereafter the *Benedicamus*, or in its stead a German psalm.

At Christmas the hymn in its place was "Dank sagen wir alle" (Let us all give thanks to God), the German form of the Christmas sequence *Grates nunc omnes* (Let us all now give thanks; §8.8.3). Nördlingen used it in the festal service held in place of matins. **Nördlingen, *Ordnung der ceremonien* at St George's, 1555** (Sehling 12, p. 321):

6. Thereupon the versicle and collect of the feast, out of Luther's little songbook. 7. For the close, "Thanks say we all" at Christmas; otherwise the *Benedicamus*.

The Wolfenbüttel convents made the same choice at morning prayer, all the year round. **Wolfenbüttel, *Kirchenordnung*, 1569** (Sehling 6/1, pp. 260–261):

thereupon sing a pure collect in German or Latin, and lastly conclude with the *Benedicamus* or "Thanks say we all," etc.

- Pfalz-Zweibrücken closed both the morning and the afternoon service of Christmas Day with "Conclusion: Let us all give thanks" (§8.16.10; Sehling 18, p. 340).
- Hof closed its Christmas matins, after the German collect, with a *Leise* (Leise (a vernacular hymn ending Kyrieleis)) in the place of the conclusion. **Hof, *Ordo ecclesiasticus*, 1592** (Sehling 11, p. 413):

"Let us pray," etc. In the place of the conclusion is sung "A little Child so worthy of praise," or "Praised be thou, Jesu Christ," with the last verse, "All this hath he done for us."

In the Neumark the Königsberg order of 1586, printed by Sehling only in extract, had "Verleih uns Frieden" (Grant us peace) sung instead of the Latin *Benedicamus* after the lessons and the weekday sermons (Sehling 3, pp. 236–237).

German hymns after it. More often the *Benedicamus* stayed, and a German hymn followed it. In Pomerania this was the prayer for peace, sung kneeling. **Pomerania, *Agenda*, 1569** (Sehling 4, p. 435):

After that the priest readeth a collect in German or Latin, and the choir concludeth with the *Benedicamus*, and singeth thereupon *Da pacem Domine* (Give peace, O Lord) on bended knees, in Latin or German.

At Regensburg it was a penitential psalm. **Regensburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1567** (Sehling 13, p. 461):

After the Magnificat the deacon singeth a German collect; thereupon certain boys, kneeling before the altar, [sing] *Benedicamus Domino* (Let us bless the Lord), and the choir *Deo gratias*; and forthwith a German penitential psalm, the *Miserere* or *De profundis* (Out of the depths): "Have mercy on me," etc., "O Lord God, be gracious to me," "Out of deep need," or "Through Adam's fall," etc.

The Wolfenbüttel village vespers followed it with "Erhalt uns, Herr, bey deinem wort" (Keep us, Lord, by thy word) (Sehling 6/1, p. 154). The Nürnberg Mass of 1525 followed it with "Es woll uns Gott genädig sein" (May God be gracious to us; above).

8.16.10 *Puer natus in Bethlehem* and the festal songs

The old Latin songs of the feasts were kept in the schools, often "Latin and German". They were sung in Latin by the scholars and in German by the girls or the people, verse about. The corpus puts them at four places. None of these is the *Benedicamus* itself.

After the Magnificat. At Naumburg the ordinary Sunday vespers ended with the Magnificat and its antiphon, "or else a short song of the season", and then the collect and *Benedicamus*. **Naumburg, St Wenzel, *Kirchen-Ordnung*, 1537/1538** (Sehling 2,

p. 72):

6. The Magnificat with its antiphon, "Christ our Saviour," or else a short song according to the season; and they have at this time three tones, the sixth, the seventh and the *peregrinus*. 7. After that one concludeth with the collect and *Benedicamus*.

At Christmas that short song was *Puer natus in Bethlehem* (A child is born in Bethlehem) or one of its fellows (Sehling 2, p. 76):

At vespers: "Christ we should praise fair," before the sermon; the Magnificat of the sixth tone after the sermon; upon the Magnificat, *In dulci jubilo* (In sweet rejoicing), or "From heaven high," or *Puer natus in Bethlehem*. The like is kept also at the Circumcision, the Epiphany and the Purification.

Nördlingen copied the passage word for word in 1555 (Sehling 12, p. 321). This is the nearest the corpus comes to *Puer natus* at the *Benedicamus*. It is the last chant before the collect and the *Benedicamus*, in the place of the Magnificat antiphon, but it does not replace or trope the *Benedicamus*. At Brieg the Christmas song was joined to the Magnificat itself. **Brieg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1592** (Sehling 3, p. 445):

thereupon the sermon; after the sermon is held, the Magnificat [with] *Resonet in laudibus* (Let it resound in praises); and concluded with the *Benedicamus*.

The order does not say whether *Resonet* was sung between the verses of the Magnificat or after it. Either way the *Benedicamus* follows unchanged.

At the entrance and the going out. The Pomeranian *Agenda* let the schoolmaster choose *Puer natus in Bethlehem*, *In dulci jubilo*, *Resonet in laudibus* or *Nunc angelorum gloria* (Now the glory of the angels) "for the entrance or the going out" at Christmas vespers (§8.16.2; Sehling 4, p. 435). Sung for the going out, such a song came after the *Benedicamus* and *Da pacem* (Give peace; §8.16.9). At Hof the three days of Christmas vespers opened with a different Latin song each day, with the German sung alongside. **Hof, *Ordo ecclesiasticus*, 1592** (Sehling 11, p. 433):

At vespers. On the first day, *In natali Domini* (At the birth of the Lord); on the second, *Parvulus nobis nascitur* (A little child is born to us); on the third, *Puer natus in Bethlehem* in four voices, so that the scholars sing the Latin, the girls the German. Then let the hymn "Christ we should praise fair" be joined to it.

Epiphany vespers began the same way ("Initio: Puer natus in Bethlehem: A 4", p. 434). Hof's calendar of figured music puts the song at the moment the scholars came into the church, and does the same at Easter (Sehling 11, pp. 458, 461):

At vespers. As the scholars enter the church, *Puer natus in Bethlehem* is sung for 4, so that the girls sing the German verses to it.

At vespers. While they go in, in the first year *Surrexit Christus hodie* (Christ is risen today), for 4; in the second, *Surrexit Christus Dominus* (Christ the Lord is risen), for 4; to which the girls add the German.

In the school. The Pomeranian order made the children learn these songs. **Pomerania, *Kerckenordeninge*, 1569** (Sehling 4, pp. 401–402):

Item, the old songs of the feasts. At Christmas: *Puer natus in Bethlehem*, Latin and German; *Nunc angelorum gloria*; *Resonet in laudibus*; "Joseph, dear Joseph mine"; *In dulci jubilo*; *Dies est laetitiae* (It is a day of gladness). […] At Easter: *Surrexit Christus hodie*, with the German "Arisen is the holy Christ," etc. At Pentecost: *Spiritus sancti gratia* (The grace of the Holy Spirit), Latin and German. And whatever other old songs there are of the like, these shall be diligently taught to the children.

The Lüneburg convent orders also name *Puer natus*, *In dulci jubilo* and *Dies est laetitiae* among the "Christian songs" of the high feasts (Sehling 6/1, pp. 614, 621).

For the introit, and after the catechism or sermon. At Sulzfeld (1566) the choir sang "Ein Kind geboren zu Bethlehem" (A child is born in Bethlehem) in the place of the Christmas introit (§8.5). A late Bischofswerda order, printed from a letter of the council to the cantor of 1676, opens every Sunday with a song of the season "for the introit". **Bischofswerda, *Gottesdienst-Ordnung*** (Sehling 2, p. 106):

1. For the introit: in Advent, "Now come, the Saviour of the heathen"; at Christmas, *Puer natus in Bethlehem*; at Shrovetide, "Christ, who [maketh] us," etc.; at Easter, *Surrexit Christus* (Christ is risen), etc.; at Pentecost, *Spiritus sancti gratia*; at Trinity, "God the Father dwell [with us]," etc.

Pfalz-Zweibrücken spread the Christmas songs over the afternoon service. **Pfalz-Zweibrücken, *Ordnung der Kirchengesänge*, 1565** (Sehling 18, p. 340):

Afternoon. Introit: "From heaven high, there came I here," etc.; "Praised be thou," etc. After the catechism: *Puer natus in Bethlehem*. After the sermon: *In dulci jubilo*. Close: "Thanks say we," etc.

At Hof the Christmas weekday services put *In dulci jubilo*, *Resonet in laudibus* and *Nunc angelorum gloria* before or after the sermon. They were sung "by turns", Latin and German by turns (Sehling 11, pp. 433–434).

Summary.

- The *Benedicamus* was kept as a short versicle and response. Its melody was graded by season: *in adventu* (in Advent), *angelicum* (angelic [Kyrie]) at Christmas, *dominicale* (Sunday [Kyrie]), and with alleluia at Easter and Pentecost.
- Where it was enlarged, this was done in two ways. Figured music could put a motet of the feast "in place of the Benedicamus". A German hymn could take its place, at Christmas "Dank sagen wir alle" (Let us all give thanks to God). Neither is a trope inside the *Benedicamus*.
- *Puer natus in Bethlehem* and the other festal songs stood next to the *Benedicamus*, not in it. They came upon the Magnificat, at the entrance or going out of vespers, for the introit, and after the catechism or sermon, with Latin and German verses alternating.
- The one judgement on the long *Benedicamus* melodies in the corpus rejects them (Neuenrade 1564).

8.17 Hymns at the occasional rites

The rites outside the Sunday service had their own small sets of hymns. Each rite drew on a fixed handful. The choice within the handful was left to the pastor or schoolmaster, or to the family's wishes and purse.

Rite	Hymns named
Baptism	"Christ unser Herr zum Jordan kam" (Christ our Lord came to the Jordan); "Vater unser" (Our Father); stanzas of "Durch Adams Fall" (Through Adam's fall all is wholly corrupted); "Herr, schaff uns wie die kleinen Kind" (Lord, make us as the little children)
Wedding	Ps 128 "Wohl dem, der in Gottes Furcht steht" (Blessed is he who stands in the fear of God); Ps 127 "Wo Gott zum Haus nicht gibt sein Gunst" (If God does not give his favour to the house); "Nun bitten" (Now pray we the Holy Ghost); Te Deum; "Dein Eh sollst du bewahren rein" (Thou shalt keep thy marriage pure; the sixth commandment)
The sick and dying	"Aus tiefer Not" (Out of deep distress); "Mit Fried und Freud" (With peace and joy I depart); "Nun freut euch" (Now rejoice); the baptism and communion hymns
Burial	"Mitten wir im Leben sind" (In the midst of life we are; with or after *Media vita* [In the midst of life]); "Mit Fried und Freud"; "Aus tiefer Not"; "Nun lasst uns den Leib begraben" (Now let us bury the body); "Wir glauben all" (We all believe); *Si bona suscepimus* (If we have received good things); *Jam moesta quiesce* (Now cease, sorrowing one)
Ordination and installation	"Nun bitten" or "Komm heiliger Geist" (Come, Holy Ghost); "Wir glauben" (We believe); Te Deum or "Dank sagen wir alle" (Let us all give thanks to God); *Veni creator* (Come, Creator); *Veni sancte Spiritus* (Come, Holy Spirit)
Thanksgiving days	Te Deum; Ps 124 "Wo Gott der Herr nicht bei uns hält" (If God the Lord does not stand by us); Ps 127

The rites themselves are treated in Chapter 13: baptism in §13.3, marriage in §13.7, the sick in §13.8, burial in §13.9, and ordination and installation in §§13.10–13.11.

8.17.1 Baptism

Hof gives a reason for singing at baptism at all: so that two actions do not follow each other without a song, with an unaccustomed silence between them. Before a baptism at the weekday service, the hymn stanza sung was the one that matched

the catechism lesson just read. **Hof, *Ordo ecclesiasticus*, 1592** (Sehling 11, p. 430):

after the lesson is ended, on the feasts and Sundays at vespers (now straightway after the sermon), something shall be sung, that two actions may not follow one upon the other without a song, and an unaccustomed silence fall between. And while the Ten Commandments are being read, that same commandment out of the longer Ten Commandments shall always be sung which was treated in the said lesson. While the creed is being read, at the first article shall be sung "God the Father be with us"; at the second, "Jesus Christ be with us"; at the third, "Holy Ghost be with us," etc. While the Our Father is being read, to every petition a stanza out of Doctor Martin's Our Father shall be sung. When baptism is read of, that stanza out of the song "Christ our Lord to Jordan came" shall be sung which the order of the exposition bringeth with it. When the office of the keys or absolution is read of, "As truly as I live" shall be sung.

Through the rest of the year the baptism hymn ran on from one baptism to the next. One stanza was sung before the baptism and the next after it, and when the hymn was finished it began again (Sehling 11, p. 431):

Thereafter through the whole year, "Christ our Lord to Jordan came" (one stanza before, the next after the baptism, and when it is out, begun again from the front). At the close of the daily service one may at times sing the remaining stanzas of this song to the end.

Ysenburg-Birstein, *Kirchenordnung*, 1588 (Sehling 10, p. 628):

Then the schoolmaster shall first sing a baptismal song, as "Christ our Lord to Jordan came," or "Lord, make us as the little children," etc.

Mansfeld, *Kirchen-Agenda*, 1580 (Sehling 2, p. 236):

At baptism it is the custom in some places in the country to sing "Our Father in the kingdom of heaven," or "Christ our Lord to Jordan came," or some verses out of the song "Through Adam's fall is all corrupt," etc.

Cochstedt, *Kirchen-Ordnung*, 1556 (Sehling 2, p. 484):

At baptism the scholars sing "Christ our Lord to Jordan."

In Lüneburg, children were baptized between the epistle and the gospel of the Sunday Mass. The litany-hymn "Nim von uns" (Take from us) was then left out (§8.8.9).

8.17.2 Weddings

The wedding psalms were Psalm 127 and Psalm 128, in their metrical forms. **Saxony (Albertine), *Kirchenordnung*, 1539**, variants (Sehling 1, p. 274):

First, that the hundred and twenty-seventh psalm be sung, or the hundred and twenty-eighth. After the psalm a lesson shall be read out of one of the evangelists or of St Paul's epistles that serveth hereto, namely the gospel of John in the second chapter, "There was a marriage in Cana of Galilee," etc., item to the Ephesians in the fifth chapter, or the like. Thereafter let "Now pray we the Holy Ghost" be sung.

Ysenburg-Birstein, *Kirchenordnung*, 1588 (Sehling 10, p. 632):

Before the sermon shall be sung the hundred and twenty-seventh psalm, "Where God the Lord giveth not his favour," etc., and the Christian creed. Thereupon followeth the sermon with the prayer, as the customary weekday sermons are otherwise held. After the sermon is held, the hundred and twenty-eighth psalm is sung, "Blessed is he that standeth in God's fear," etc.

In Hof, and in the Henneberg village of Goldlauter, the sixth commandment was sung after the marriage, from Luther's Ten Commandments hymn, with its last stanza. **Hof, *Ordo ecclesiasticus*, 1592** (Sehling 11, p. 430):

before the marriage is sung "Blessed is he that standeth in God's fear"; after the marriage, "Where God to the house giveth not his," etc., or else "Thy marriage shalt thou keep pure," out of Luther's German Decalogue, with the last [stanza] added, "Help us to this, Lord Jesu Christ."

Goldlauter (Henneberg), *Kirchen-Ordnung*, 1566 (Sehling 2, p. 333):

then it is the custom first to sing the *Veni sancte* in the short melody, and thereupon "A mighty fortress," and thereafter the creed; meanwhile the people go to the offering. Then I hold a wedding sermon in the pulpit. After the sermon is sung "Blessed is he that standeth in God's fear," and both spouses are joined together […]. At the close is sung again the sixth commandment, "Thy marriage shalt thou keep pure," and "Help us to this, the Lord Jesus Christ."

Osnabrück sang the German or Latin Te Deum and Psalm 128 before the bridal Mass. **Osnabrück (Stift), *Kirchenordnung*, 1543** (Sehling 7/1, p. 225):

And when the bride goeth to church, there shall be sung before the bridal Mass the *Te Deum laudamus* (We praise thee, O God) in German or Latin, and the psalm "Blessed is he that standeth in God's fear," etc.

In Hamburg the families could hire the organist and cantor for more. **Hamburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1529** (Sehling 5, p. 516):

There one may then in the church play upon the organs and sing with the scholars *Te Deum laudamus*, or something else of God, or also in figured music, etc., as the folk have then ordered it with the organist and cantor for their drink-money.

Hohenlohe gave a wedding set for weekday weddings. **Hohenlohe, *Schul- und Gesangsordnung*, 1596** (Sehling 15, p. 656):

At weddings in the week: before the sermon shall be sung "Now they that here," etc., "Blessed are all they that," etc.; after the sermon, before the marriage, "May God be gracious unto us," etc., or a Gloria; after the marriage, "Blessed is he that in God's fear," etc.

8.17.3 The sick and the dying

The Regensburg order gives a short list of hymns for those who attended the dying: "grounded psalms and songs", not "old erroneous prayers and sayings". **Regensburg, *Kirchenordnung* of Hieronymus Noppus, 1543** (Sehling 13, p. 410):

[they shall] say the Our Father and the creed before them, and, where there is time, grounded psalms and songs, as "Out of the depths I cry to thee," etc., "In peace and joy I now depart," "Now rejoice, dear Christians all," [the songs] of baptism, of the sacrament of the body and blood, etc.; not old, erroneous prayers and sayings.

8.17.4 Burial

The burial hymn named first everywhere is Luther's "Mitten wir im Leben sind" (In the midst of life we are), often after the Latin *Media vita* (In the midst of life). The Saxon Visitation Articles of 1528 already ask for it. **Saxony (Ernestine), *Unterricht der Visitatoren*, 1528** (Sehling 1, p. 170):

and at the burial let the German song "In the midst of life" be sung.

Brandenburg sets the hymns by the course of the procession: "Mitten wir im Leben" (In the midst of life we are) on the way, "Aus tiefer Not" (Out of deep distress) if the way was long, and Simeon's song on the return to church. **Brandenburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1540** (Sehling 3, p. 81):

when the corpse is carried, one may sing *Media vita* and the three German verses, "In the midst of life we are," and, if the way be too long, the German *De profundis*, "Out of the depths," or else the responsory *Libera me Domine* (Deliver me, O Lord). And when one goeth again from the burial into the church, then one may sing "In peace and joy I now depart."

Hof adds "Aus tiefer Not" "with the slow melody" when needed, and graded its funerals by the number of school classes that attended. **Hof, *Ordo ecclesiasticus*, 1592** (Sehling 11, p. 475):

Hence follow German songs, to be used also at private funerals, at which the third, fourth and fifth classes attend under the cantor's lead in winter, and in summer the sixth also, namely: "In the midst of life we are"; "God the Father be with us"; Luther's "In peace and joy I now depart." Item, if need require, when the aforesaid are finished before the boys have entered St Lawrence's church, there are added "Out of the depths," to be sung with the slow melody, and "Have mercy on me, O Lord God."

Several orders split the burial hymn around the sermon. **Schwäbisch Hall, *Kirchenordnung*, 1543/1615** (Sehling 17/1, p. 174):

one shall sing "Now let us bury the body," etc., until the verse "Now let we him sleep here," etc. Thereupon one of the ministers, of whom it hath been desired, shall hold a Christian, fitting funeral sermon, agreeable to the present business.

Limpurg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1610 (Sehling 16, p. 623):

In the church at Münster, when the congregation assembleth, either the song "In the midst of life we are," etc., again wholly, and after the sermon "Now let us bury the body," etc.; or this song before the sermon until the two last stanzas, "Now let we him sleep here," etc., and the same then after the sermon.

Hohenlohe, *Schul- und Gesangsordnung*, 1596 (Sehling 15, p. 656):

In the procession out with the corpse to the grave, and into the church before the sermon, shall be sung "In the midst of life," etc., "In peace and joy," etc., "God the Father be with us," etc., "When my last hour is come," etc. But after the sermon "Now let us [bury] the body," etc. shall be sung at the grave.

Schwarzburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1574 (Sehling 2, p. 136):

Then the body is buried in the earth; the school boys sing, while it is being buried, Luther's song "Now let us bury the body."

The Kurland order lists the hymns for before the funeral sermon, "as many as it pleaseth". **Kurland, *Kirchenordnung*, 1570** (Sehling 5, p. 105):

"In peace and joy I now depart." "Have mercy on me, O Lord God." "Out of the depths." "In the midst of life." The responsory *Si bona suscepimus* (If we have received good things) and the like. "I believe in God the Father Almighty." "We believe." These psalms and songs one useth before the funeral sermon, as many as it pleaseth.

Rostock, *Conformitas ceremoniarum*, c. 1560 (Sehling 5, p. 290):

At the funerals of godly Christians shall be sung, in Latin and German, *Si bona suscepimus*, *Media vita*, *Scio quod redemptor meus* (I know that my redeemer [liveth]), "In peace and joy," "Out of the depths," "Have mercy on me," "Now let us bury the body."

The words "of godly Christians" matter. Singing was an honour, and it could be withheld. A later Nürnberg regulation, printed with the Brandenburg-Nürnberg order, forbids the hymns of Christian hope for those who died unrepentant, because of the offence. It gives them the penitential hymns instead. **Brandenburg-Nürnberg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1533**, later appendix (Sehling 11, p. 202):

for these the ordinary songs, "In peace and joy I now depart according to God's will," etc., and other such Christian songs as fit not such cases, cannot be sung before the house and in the going forth, to avoid offence. But before the door there might be sung "In the midst of life we are," etc., and in the going forth, "As truly as I live, saith thy God," etc., item other songs of repentance.

At Strasbourg there was no singing unless it was asked for, and then no funeral sermon either. **Strasbourg, *Gottesdienstordnung*, 1577** (Sehling 20/1, p. 518):

before and after the sermon is sung either "In the midst of life we are," or "In peace and joy I now depart," item "Now let us bury the body." But where it is not desired, even as one singeth not, so one also holdeth no funeral sermon.

The Leiningen order abolished the old "singing over" the dead with holy water, but allowed the scholars to sing German hymns. **Leiningen-Westerburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1566** (Sehling 19/1, p. 267):

all popish pomp with holy water, singing over [the dead], and other things, etc. [shall] be done away. For such was set up not only without God's word but also against God's word, as though it should be furthersome to salvation. Now where there are schools, the scholars may well sing some German songs, as "In the midst of life we are," "Now lettest thou thy servant depart in peace," etc.

The Goslar order of 1528 left the whole matter to "a godly, reasonable, learned pastor". **Goslar, Amsdorf, *Vom teglichen gots dinst*, 1528** (Sehling 7/2.2, pp. 237–238):

That a chaplain, the sexton and also the scholars go along, I allow to be done, and [that they] sing in German and Latin *Media vita*, a psalm, etc. All this standeth with a godly, reasonable, learned pastor to lessen and to increase, that he order it as it shall be best and most profitable for the people.

8.17.5 Ordination and installation

The ordination and installation rites of the Württemberg family open with "Nun bitten" (Now pray we the Holy Ghost). The creed is sung after the sermon, and the service closes with the Te Deum or the German *Grates*. **Württemberg, *Synodalordnung*, 1547** (Sehling 16, p. 159):

And when the people are assembled in the church, one shall begin and sing "Now pray we the Holy Ghost," etc. After this song the dean or one of the councillors shall stand up and hold a sermon of the ministry of the word [...]. After the sermon the creed shall be sung.

Lippe (1571) copies the rite, and the superintendent steps before the altar during the creed (Sehling 21, p. 438):

when the people are assembled in the church, [they shall] sing at the beginning "Now pray we the Holy Ghost," etc.; after this song the superintendent or his adjunct [shall] stand up and hold a sermon of the ministry of the word.

Lauenburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1585 (Sehling 5, p. 408):

The people, first assembled in the church, shall sing some psalms, and thereafter at the last there shall follow "Now pray we the Holy Ghost," or "Come, Holy Ghost, Lord God."

The Brandenburg installation adds Psalm 67 and the Te Deum. **Brandenburg, *Visitations- und Consistorialordnung*, 1573** (Sehling 3, p. 109):

after the Our Father is spoken the congregation shall sing "Now pray we the Holy Ghost," and "May God be gracious unto us and give his blessing," etc., item the *Te Deum laudamus* (We praise thee, O God), etc.

The Hessian ordination (Philippist) closes with the Te Deum "where there are schools", or "Dank sagen wir alle" (Let us all give thanks to God). **Hessen, *Agende*, 1574** (Philippist; Sehling 8, p. 455):

At the close the congregation shall sing *Te Deum laudamus*, in German, or in Latin where there are schools, or "Thanks say we all to God our Lord Christ," etc., or another such song of praise.

The Merseburg draft for Luther's ordinations has *Veni creator* (Come, Creator) sung while ordinator and ordinands kneel. **Merseburg, *Ordinations-Ordnung*, 1545** (Sehling 2, p. 7):

Credo in unum. The people: "We believe." The choir: *Veni creator*, during which the lord ordinator together with the ordinands should kneel down together before the altar.

8.17.6 Days of thanksgiving and extraordinary occasions

Michaelmas in Schleswig-Holstein was a harvest thanksgiving, with the Te Deum after the sermon. **Schleswig-Holstein, *Kirchenordnung*, 1542** (Sehling 23, p. 95):

The day of Michael is a common thanksgiving for all the fruits which we have gathered and received in the year. Therefore the whole congregation shall, straight after the sermon, sing for the thanksgiving with great devotion *Te Deum Laudamus* (We praise thee, O God), etc.

Lüneburg kept an annual day for the city's deliverance. On it hymns took the place of the propers: Psalm 127 (figural) and Psalm 124 after the epistle, and Psalm 124 again with Psalm 3 at matins. **Lüneburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1575** (Sehling 6/1, p. 663):

At the Mass: 4. the introit *Benedicite* (Bless ye) of the angels; 5. the Kyrie in figured music, item *Et in terra pax* (And on earth peace), next "To God alone on high be glory"; 6. after the reading of the epistle, *Nisi Dominus aedificaverit domum* (Except the Lord build the house); 7. "Were God not with us"; 8. the gospel is sung; 9. "Now pray we the Holy Ghost"; 10. the holy sermon is held; 11. after the sermon the litany is sung.

At Nördlingen's thanksgiving day on 7 January, Psalm 124 could be sung instead of a figured piece, "that the congregation also may have cause to thank God". **Nördlingen, *Kirchenordnung*, 1579** (Sehling 12, p. 388):

The choir singeth a piece in figured music; or, that the congregation also may have cause to thank God, the psalm "Where God the Lord standeth not by us," etc. may be sung.

At an execution in Regensburg the crowd sang "Nun bitten" (Now pray we the Holy Ghost) while the condemned man began to recite the creed. **Regensburg, *Kirchenordnung* of Justus Jonas, 1553**, with the order for the condemned (Sehling 13, p. 426):

Then that he openly profess the faith and recite the Apostles' Creed, *Credo in Deum Patrem* (I believe in God the Father), etc. But at the beginning of it the crowd standing about shall sing the song "Now pray we the Holy Ghost."

8.18 How hymns were chosen: the reasons given

The orders seldom explain a single choice. They often state the rules by which choices were to be made. Ten kinds of reason recur. They are gathered here with the quotations not already given in the sections on the slots.

8.18.1 From Scripture, and "pure"

The first test is always the text. Anything sung, Latin or German, must come from Scripture or be proved by it. **Hamburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1529**, section "Of singing" (Sehling 5, p. 516):

All singing, German and Latin, as hath been said, shall be out of the holy Scripture, or proved by God's clear words and the Christian faith, as Paul teacheth to sing, Ephesians 5; as also the old Christian doctors sang and caused to be sung, when men knew nothing of the *Salve regina* and other unchristian songs.

Buxtehude applies the test to the Latin chants. It keeps those "agreeable to divine Scripture" and drops the rest. **Buxtehude, *Kirchenordnung*, 1552** (Sehling 7/1, p. 77):

All Latin songs agreeable to divine Scripture which have hitherto been sung in the church at Mass, matins and vespers at their special time shall be kept, used and sung at their time. But those that are unserviceable, not agreeable to divine Scripture, and wrong, shall not be sung.

Worms admits hymns as well as psalms, because Paul commended both. But no new hymn is to be brought in without the superintendent and preachers. **Worms, *Agendbüchlein*, 1560** (Sehling 19/1, p. 208):

Since the holy apostle Paul hath commended and enjoined to Christians not only the psalms of David but also other spiritual songs and hymns of praise, we also reject them not, yet so far as they be Christian and grounded in holy Scripture. Only that no new song be brought into the church without the counsel and foreknowledge of the superintendents and preachers.

In Württemberg every communion hymn beyond the named ones had to be "examined and admitted" by the superintendents first. **Württemberg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1536** (Sehling 16, p. 109):

or other songs of praise which are pure [...] and have been beforehand viewed, examined and admitted by the superintendents.

8.18.2 Fitting the feast and the season

The Saxon Visitation Articles of 1528 thought it "unseemly that the songs are quite alike at all feasts". **Saxony (Ernestine), *Unterricht der Visitatoren*, 1528** (Sehling 1, p. 169):

Since it is also unseemly that the songs are quite alike at all feasts, it were good that on the most glorious feasts one sang the Latin introits, Gloria [etc.].

Bugenhagen asked the schoolmasters to see that "the songs rhyme finely with the feasts". Where no proper song existed, they were to take "the most joyful psalms or songs". **Braunschweig, *Kirchenordnung*, 1528** (Sehling 6/1, p. 442). The same sentence recurs in Mecklenburg (1545):

The schoolmasters shall see to it that the songs rhyme finely with the feasts. When they have no songs for them, let them take the most joyful psalms or songs, and see always that the songs be out of the pure Scripture, and pure and pleasant and understandable for the laity, made out of God's word.

The Kurpfalz order of 1556 wants the songs to follow "the teaching and the order of the season", so that the church is reminded of the necessary articles "both with preaching and singing". **Kurpfalz, *Kirchenordnung*, 1556** (Sehling 14, p. 165):

One shall also be diligent that the songs be ordered after the teaching and the order of the season: namely, on Christmas Day and the feasts following, of the birth of Christ; at Easter, of the resurrection of Christ; that the church may be well reminded of the necessary pieces of the teaching of the Christian faith, both with preaching and singing.

The Sayn *Kirchenzuchtordnung* of 1582 repeats this almost word for word (Sehling 19/1, p. 369). Hanau-Lichtenberg (1573) opens its three rules with the same point (§8.11.5).

The Württemberg court church order of 1560 made the court preachers settle the hymns with the choirmaster, so that the singing followed the season and not "his own nod". **Württemberg, *Hofkirchenordnung*, 1560** (Sehling 16, p. 428):

The court preachers shall also always agree with the choirmaster what he shall sing, and that the singing fit the season according to the order above, and be not sung at his own nod, as hath hitherto been done.

8.18.3 Fitting the gospel and the sermon

The later orders go further. The hymn is to agree with the gospel and "the chief teaching of the sermon". **Öhringen, *Kirchen- und Schulordnungen*, 1582**, the German school order (Sehling 15, p. 503):

He shall, according to our church order, be diligent at all times as much as possible to sing such psalms as agree with the customary gospels and the chief teaching of the sermon. He shall also on the Sunday speak beforehand with the organist and agree what he will sing, that there be no confusion and disorder.

The Hohenlohe *Gesangsordnung* of 1596 gives the reason in its closing paragraph. When the hymns are fitted to the sermons, the common man will feel that the singing is "no superfluous or vain ceremony" but "a short summary and pleasant instruction". It also forbids cutting psalms off in the middle. **Hohenlohe, *Schul- und Gesangsordnung*, 1596** (Sehling 15, p. 657):

that the pastors, with good consideration, as much as possible, will direct all songs before and after to the sermons; that the common man, by means of divine grace, may feel in his heart that the singing is not a superfluous or vain ceremony, but a short summary and pleasant instruction, whereby all manner of things necessary to be known for salvation are brought home to our hearts most fairly and lovely.

The Kassel general synod of 1607 (Reformed) asked for the hymn numbers to be posted on a board at the church doors, and for an order of hymns "by the seasons of the year and fitted to the texts that are to be preached". **Hessen-Kassel, *Abschied der Kasseler Generalsynode*, 1607** (Reformed; Sehling 9, pp. 75–76):

that the psalms which are to be sung in the assembly be at all times marked with their number by the bell-ringer or sexton (who should first inquire of the psalm from him that is to hold the sermon) upon a little board at the doors of the church, or as it might otherwise be fitly done according to the condition of the church.

that it were not unserviceable that the psalms and other Christian songs be drawn up into a certain order according to the seasons of the year, and accommodated to the texts which should be preached, and communicated to the pastors, especially in the country.

8.18.4 That the people may learn them: few, familiar, often repeated

A second group of reasons concerns the congregation's knowledge. The fewer the hymns, the sooner they are learned. The Sponheim order uses the longest hymns before the sermon and the shortest after it. It also prints a short list of hymns to be used "often and before others". **Hintere Grafschaft Sponheim, *Kirchen- und Zensurordnung*, 1590/91** (Sehling 18, p. 657):

In towns and market towns where there are schools, the songs and psalms that are found in the church order may for the most part be used in the churches; yet with this common direction, that at the beginning and before the sermon the longest, but after the sermon the shortest be sung. And that the common people be not burdened with many songs, but the sooner learn to sing, it is needful that some chief psalms and songs be used oftener and before others, [rather than] hard songs unfit for them. And accordingly the following songs shall be used often and before others; yet where a congregation hath already learned more songs contained in the church order, these shall hereby not be forbidden.

Danzig wanted the same hymns used "two [Sundays] running", especially those that contained the parts of the catechism. **Danzig, *Kirchenordnung*, 1557**, as summarised and quoted by Sehling (Sehling 4, p. 168):

A psalm, two or three, "according to the occasion of the season, which the whole church also shall learn and sing along; and therefore the same songs shall often be used some two [times] one after another, namely those in which the pieces of the catechism are orderly comprised."

Mecklenburg sang German hymns before and after the weekday sermons "that they may become known and common to the people, and hearts be thereby stirred to prayer". **Mecklenburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1552** (Sehling 5, p. 201):

On such days German spiritual songs shall be sung before and after the sermon, that they may become known and common to the people, and hearts be thereby stirred up to prayer; as especially "Our Father in the kingdom of heaven," "Were God the Lord not with us," "A mighty fortress," etc.

Reutlingen listed the psalm-hymns that had once been "common and known in the church" and wanted all of them brought back. The feast hymns it did not list, "for they are otherwise known well enough". **Reutlingen, *Ordnung der Schule und des Kirchengesangs*, 1565/1566** (Sehling 17/2, p. 51):

These psalms have all been common and known in the church; they shall therefore all be brought back into it. The songs for the special high feasts we have not wished to list here, for they are otherwise known well enough.

Hesse (Moderate Reformed) wanted the sung psalms explained in sermons, "for what one understandeth not goeth slowly to the heart". **Hessen, *Kirchenordnung*, 1566** (Moderate Reformed; Sehling 8, p. 255):

But especially it goeth not off without fruit when the psalms are expounded, above all those that are sung by the whole congregation; for so they understand the better all that is done by the church in the holy assembly. The minds also are the more kindled to devotion and godly meditation under the singing; for what one understandeth not goeth slowly to the heart.

Sayn, *Kirchenzuchtordnung*, 1582 (Sehling 19/1, p. 369):

the pastors shall exhort the people to learn the Christian songs and psalms and to help praise and extol our Lord God with the common singing of the church, that through the songs they may be reminded of God's word that is comprised therein, and thereby be bettered in the right knowledge of God, in faith, love, patience and all other virtues. And that a good order and uniformity may be kept in the songs, the songs chiefly that are Doctor Martin Luther's [shall be used] […].

8.18.5 Luther's hymns first

From the 1560s several orders put Luther's hymns ahead of all others. The Prussian order of 1568 gives the reason: in them "the whole holy catechism" is set out "with rich, fair and mighty exposition". **Prussia, *Kirchenordnung und Ceremonien*, 1568** (Sehling 4, p. 75):

But not all manner of German songs shall be sung in the church, in villages as in towns, but chiefly Luther's psalms shall be kept and used. For in them one hath most fairly the whole holy catechism with rich, fair and mighty exposition: first, of the Ten Commandments in two songs, "These are the holy ten commandments," etc., and "Man, wilt thou live blessedly," etc.; secondly, the articles of our Christian faith in "We all believe in one God," etc.; thirdly, the prayer in "Our Father in the kingdom of heaven," etc.; the whole treasure of holy baptism in "Christ our Lord to Jordan came," etc.; and then all needful instruction of the holy Supper in "Jesus Christ our Saviour," etc., and "God be praised," etc. Whoso then will have the sum of sums, together with the use and profit thereof, briefly together, let him sing "Now rejoice, dear Christians all," etc., or Doctor Speratus's most fair psalm, "Salvation now is come to us," etc.

It then turns on the new hymn-writers (Sehling 4, p. 76):

So that it is not needful to snatch up all manner of new songs and bring them into the churches. We have them, God be praised, as good as they can be made, and there is lack nowhere, save that men are weary and tired of the precious treasure and have lust and love to take up something new; until at last they come away almost wholly from the glorious psalms of Luther, and everyone bringeth forward his own poem, which yet cannot hold a candle to Luther in the kind of diction or the weight of matter. Therefore the pastors shall see to it that they suffer not the schoolmasters to sing at their own pleasure, but take care that the songs above be kept and diligently used.

Hoya says the same, and warns that where everyone wants to be a poet, error easily takes root. It also places boys among the people to teach them. **Hoya, *Kirchenordnung*, 1581** (Sehling 6/2, p. 1151):

The pastors shall diligently keep the psalms that were made by Doctor Luther and that have been had and sung from the beginning of the gospel, and use them diligently, and bestow great diligence that the people in the church may always sing the second verse and the choir meanwhile keep silence. For the furtherance of this a pair of boys may be made to stand or sit among the people, who sing, so that the people accustom themselves to singing along with them. Other Christian songs also may well be used, so far as they be pure and agreeable to God's word; yet let not too much novelty be made, nor the old songs rejected. For it is found that where every man will be a poet and make and use his own songs, error may easily take root therewith.

Harlingerland, *Kirchenordnung*, 1573/74 (Sehling 7/1, p. 738):

The twelfth article, first section: of the songs which shall be used in the church. We ordain that the psalms which were made by Doctor Luther of blessed memory and are found in the psalm books shall be sung and used most of all, before others. Yet hereby we will not have rejected the praiseworthy songs, Latin or German, appointed for the high feast days and grounded in the divine word.

The same order forbids schoolmasters and sextons to sing hymns "at their pleasure" without the pastor's knowledge. It forbids songs the people are not used to, and songs "that have the same tune as worldly songs", at which the common man might take offence (Sehling 7/1, p. 739):

also command the schoolmasters and sextons that they sing not the psalms at their pleasure without the foreknowledge of the pastors, [nor such] as the parish folk are not yet used to, nor otherwise those that have the same tune as worldly songs, whereat the common man might be offended.

Mansfeld built its seasonal hymn plan from Luther's songbook. It marked with an asterisk the hymns in that book by "other excellent men". It did not bind other territories to its order. **Mansfeld, *Kirchen-Agenda*, 1580** (Sehling 2, p. 235):

We have therefore taken Doctor Luther's German songbook before us, and divided the songs contained therein among the feasts and common Sundays and otherwise other days, as we suppose in our simplicity that they should be most fitting to the sermons and best to be impressed upon the people. But because in Luther's songbook good and spiritual songs of other excellent men also are incorporated, we would not leave them out, but have set them in at fitting places, and to distinguish them from Doctor Luther's songs we have marked them with this sign: *.

The same Mansfeld article explains why hymns had spread so fast: "as all men are by nature inclined to sing and have pleasure in music" (Sehling 2, p. 235):

As now all men are naturally inclined to sing and have pleasure in music, so have they received such songs with great desire, and out of them grasped the ground of the truth firmly and strongly.

At Langenburg in Hohenlohe the question became a dispute in 1592. The pastor there, Mögner, objected that singing only Luther's hymns would mean giving up long-used songs by Spengler, Speratus, Kreuziger, Jonas and others. He appealed to the last paragraph of the 1578 order, to sing "at all times what is serviceable and answerable to the matter" (Sehling 15, p. 625):

so will we, according to the last paragraph on the songs, sing at all times what is serviceable and answerable to the matter.

8.18.6 Against private choice and novelty; the authorized books

Hof defended its whole plan against any "unskilled scholar" who might change it at his pleasure. **Hof, *Ordo ecclesiasticus*, 1592** (Sehling 11, p. 455):

since it will not become every unskilled scholar to overturn at his pleasure our fair and well-considered church order, and to sing in the congregation of God what seemeth good to him in his own name; since the old ones were also men, and surely undertook nothing without great forethought.

Pfalz-Zweibrücken closed its songbook with a ban on novelty, "that constant uniformity be kept, as well in singing as in preaching". **Pfalz-Zweibrücken, *Kirchenordnung*, 1557**, songbook (Sehling 18, p. 255):

These church songs set above the pastors and ministers shall use, and bring in no further novelty, that Christian, constant uniformity be kept as well in singing as in preaching and daily teaching.

Grubenhagen tied the whole service to Johann Spangenberg's cantional. **Grubenhagen, *Kirchenordnung*, 1581** (Sehling 6/2, p. 1048):

the same shall be held with due modesty and discretion, orderly and with one voice, and nothing new be devised or undertaken by anyone. Since, then, the cantional or missal of the old master Johann Spangenberg hath long been customary in our principality, and the same hath been given to every church for keeping and use, every one shall diligently order himself by it on the Sundays, feasts and apostles' days in holding the office, with lessons, singing, collects, introits, Kyrie, *Patrem* (the Nicene Creed), prefaces, hymns and whatever more there is of the like, according to the order of the season.

Oldenburg required "a right, pure cantional", Spangenberg's or Lossius's, with Luther's German songbook. **Oldenburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1573** (Sehling 7/2.1, p. 1085):

For the furtherance of which it is needful that in all churches and schools a right, pure cantional be always at hand, as namely that of the old master Johann Spangenberg or of Lucas Lossius, together with the German songbook of Doctor Martin Luther.

It adds that the Luther songbook must be one "printed at no suspect place and unfalsified". This was aimed at the Reformed-leaning printings of the 1560s and 1570s (Sehling 7/2.1, p. 1087):

and before the sermon a German psalm may be sung out of Luther's songbook, [one] that is printed at no suspect place and is unfalsified.

Rostock required Lossius in every church, and one melody everywhere. **Rostock, *Conformitas ceremoniarum*, c. 1560** (Sehling 5, pp. 288–289):

It is thought good and needful that Lucas Lossius's *Psalmodia* be kept in all churches, and the choir order itself thereby.

The schoolmasters and cantors also shall be diligent that in all songs one melody be kept.

The Pomeranian *Agenda* ordered every church to buy Lossius's cantional (§8.8.6).

8.18.7 Latin and German

The orders agree that the congregation sings in German. They differ on how much Latin to keep, and why. Bugenhagen defended the Latin chants for the sake of the Latin school children. He reproved those who would have "all things and singing in German, as though it were wrong to sing a Latin word". **Braunschweig, *Kirchenordnung*, 1528** (Sehling 6/1, p. 438):

We praise not, nor do we chide, but say that they take it a little too strictly who will have all things and singing in German, as though it were wrong to sing a Latin word or another; since Paul saith rightly that one shall not forbid to speak with tongues. When the laity have the German Mass, they shall bear with the Latin children and others, that these sing at times a Latin *Gloria in excelsis*, an alleluia, Sanctus, Agnus, and special songs, as sequences on the three great feasts; yet with German sung in among them or beside them.

East Frisia kept the Latin "because we will that the Latin tongue, together with all good arts, as music, be kept in honour". **Ostfriesland, *Kirchenordnung*, 1535** (Sehling 7/1, p. 380):

For we will that the Latin tongue, together with all good arts, as music, be held in honour in the churches and schools.

Hohenlohe kept the Latin for the schools and added German "for the unlearned and those inexperienced in the Latin tongue". **Hohenlohe, *Kirchenordnung*, 1553** (Sehling 15, p. 60):

for its sake keep the Latin songs in use, and beside them also the German songs, because of the unlearned and those inexperienced in the Latin tongue.

Hesse (1574, Philippist) reasoned from 1 Corinthians 14: whoever does not understand cannot say Amen. It allowed Latin only before the congregation had gathered, and at vespers when few were there. It also limited the singing before the sermon to half an hour on feast days and a quarter of an hour on weekdays. **Hessen, *Agende*, 1574** (Philippist; Sehling 8, p. 411):

But how can one say Amen to that which he understandeth not and knoweth not what is meant thereby? 1 Corinthians 14. Therefore, as all sermons, prayer and thanksgiving are done in the known German tongue, so also the singing, when the whole common multitude is together, shall be German. But since in towns, where there are many kinds of people, many are found who

were brought up in schools and understand Latin, and likewise strangers often come to the common assemblies to whom this tongue is well known, a Latin psalm or introit may be sung at times at the beginning, before the whole congregation cometh together, and at vespers, when few people are present anyway; yet so that in the villages wholly, and in the towns for the most part, only German songs be and remain in common use. The songs also shall be set as short as may be, and before the sermon shall not be stretched on feast days over half an hour, and on working days over a quarter of an hour at the most, that the people be not held up, and be caused to weariness before the sermon beginneth.

Sayn called Latin singing in the papacy "a special punishment of God", citing Isaiah 28 and 1 Corinthians 14 (Sehling 19/1, p. 369):

that it hath hitherto happened in the papacy is to be counted a special punishment of God, as Isaiah 28 and St Paul, 1 Corinthians 14, bear witness. And it hath the appearance that such church singing, done in an unknown tongue, was supposed by the merit of its work to reconcile God's wrath.

8.18.8 Length

Long singing was to be avoided "that such Christian and wholesome ceremonies may remain pleasant to the people and not become tedious". **Pomerania, *Kirchenordnung*, 1535** (Sehling 4, p. 341):

Long singing, wherein some priests have pleasure, shall for this cause be avoided: that such Christian and wholesome ceremonies may remain pleasant to the people and not become tedious.

Two, or at most three, pieces of figured music at one service are enough, "that the people also may have room to praise God with song". **Wolfenbüttel, *Kirchenordnung*, 1543** (Sehling 6/1, p. 54):

Two good pieces, or at the most three, in figured music are enough at one time, that the people also may have room to praise God with song, especially during the communion, as Christ saith: "This do in remembrance of me."

Schönburg held weekday singing and preaching together to one hour, "so the people are kept willing to go to the sermon and can also come home to work". **Schönburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1542** (Sehling 2, p. 171):

In sum, that always in the week, on working days, all singing and preaching be done in one hour and not beyond. So the people are kept willing to go to the sermon, and can also come home to work.

8.18.9 The organ

The organ was allowed, "neither commanded nor forbidden". It was not a way of serving God, but like a trumpet that moves people to pray, hear the word, and come to church. **Bremen, *Kirchenordnung*, 1534** (Sehling 7/2.2, p. 461):

Organs and music, which are free, neither commanded nor forbidden, may be used; not in order to serve God therewith and to strengthen idolatry and hinder the right service of God, as the Papists do; but as a trumpet or else a cry, whereby men are moved and get occasion both to pray and diligently to hear God's word, even as Elisha prophesied at the harp, and to go into the church and abide there.

Heilbronn grounded the organ in the Psalms and in the pleasure of melody, which stirs the heart. **Heilbronn, *Kirchenordnung*, 1543** (Sehling 17/1, p. 317):

and since God is to be praised in all things, in organs, cymbals and stringed instruments, as is written in the holy psalms, and the heart of men also is not only gladdened and awakened by such lovely melody to tell of the divine benefits [...].

The organist was to play only after the choir or church had begun, and to agree with the schoolmaster beforehand. **Buxtehude, *Kirchenordnung*, 1552** (Sehling 7/1, p. 78):

the organist shall play at Mass, matins and vespers that which the choir or the whole church first beginneth and singeth. The schoolmaster shall always agree beforehand with the organist touching the singing, to prevent all unseemliness and confusion.

Harlingerland forbade organists to play worldly songs. **Harlingerland, *Kirchenordnung*, 1573/74** (Sehling 7/1, p. 739):

And since in places where there are organs the organists are found unfaithful and play worldly songs, whereof offence followeth, although these [organs] are not forbidden in holy Scripture, but [given] to praise and extol the Almighty therewith, we ordain that the organists attend to their service earnestly and [play] glorious spiritual pieces, agreeing with holy Scripture.

In polyphonic settings for the court chapel of Württemberg the familiar tune was to be kept in the tenor or another voice, so the people could recognize it. **Württemberg, *Hofkirchenordnung*, 1560** (Sehling 16, p. 427):

At the close a German psalm shall always be sung, and in the compositions care shall be taken that the customary, familiar melody be set in the tenor or another voice.

The organ's silence in certain seasons and the limits on what the organist might play are treated in Chapter 9, §§9.3.6–9.3.7.

8.18.10 Freedom

Many orders end their rules on singing with a clause of freedom, or leave the choice to the pastor, and some say plainly that such ceremonies are not laws. Northeim: "such things must be free and subject to no law" (§8.8.1). Goslar (1528) left the burial singing to "a godly, reasonable, learned pastor" (§8.17.4). Mansfeld did not bind others to its plan (§8.18.5). Nördlingen's St George's order (1555), after Naumburg, lets the Gloria be dropped when the hymns after the epistle are long, "for such ceremonies shall at all times be free for the pastor to change according to the people's convenience". **Nördlingen, *Ordnung der ceremonien* at St George's, 1555** (Sehling 12, p. 322):

One may also well leave out the *Gloria in excelsis* when the songs after the epistle are somewhat long; for such ceremonies shall at all times be free for the pastor to change according to the people's convenience.

8.19 Concordance of the orders quoted

Every order quoted in this chapter is listed below by region. The table gives:

- **Sehling**: the volume and pages in Sehling's edition.
- **Doc**: the `eko.db` document that holds the text, for full-text lookup. A single database record may hold several orders.
- **Hymn practice**: a short note on what the order contributes.
- **§**: the sections where the order is quoted.

Luther; Saxony and Thuringia; the Harz counties, Magdeburg, Halberstadt and Anhalt

Order	Sehling	Doc	Hymn practice	§
Wittenberg, Luther, *Formula missae*, 1523	1, pp. 6, 8–9	2	wish for vernacular songs near gradual, Sanctus, Agnus; "Gott sei gelobet" (God be praised) after communion; *Benedicamus* in place of *Ite missa*	8.3.2, 8.15.2, 8.16.8
Wittenberg, Luther, *Deutsche Messe*, 1526	1, pp. 14–15	3	German psalm at opening; hymn after epistle; "Wir glauben all" (We all believe); Sanctus, "Gott sei gelobet", Hus hymn at communion	8.3.2
Saxony (Ernestine), *Unterricht der Visitatoren*, 1528	1, pp. 169–170	9	songs to differ at feasts; "Mitten wir im Leben" (In the midst of life we are) at burial	8.17.4, 8.18.2
Saxony (Albertine), *Kirchenordnung*, 1539	1, pp. 271–275	30	sequence or German psalm "as the season requireth"; village hymn "pro introitu" (for the introit); "Christe du Lamm" (Christ, thou Lamb) to close; wedding psalms	8.5.1, 8.8.1, 8.15.1, 8.15.2, 8.17.2
Albertine Saxony, *Die Cellischen Ordnungen*, 1545	1, p. 300	33	Latin chant with kneeling prayer "in place of the offertory"	8.11.3
Saxony (Albertine), *Kirchenordnung*, 1580	1, p. 369	44	communion hymns "one or more" by number of communicants	8.14.2

Order	Sehling	Doc	Hymn practice	§
Allstedt, Thomas Müntzer, *Deutsch kirchenampt*, [1523] (Radical Reformation)	1, pp. 475–491	50	German *Benedicamus*, with alleluia at Easter	8.16.8
Dresden, *Gottesdienst-Ordnung der Kreuzkirche*, 1574	1, p. 555	78	all communion hymns sung when communicants are many	8.14.2
Eisfeld, *Verordnung der Visitatoren*, 1554	1, p. 562	84	Hus's hymn at communion	8.14.1
Pirna, *Kirchenordnung* of Anton Lauterbach, 1555	1, pp. 642–643	119	two German hymns per Sunday, by the sense of epistle and gospel	8.8.7
Weissenfels, *Ordnung der geseng*, 1578	1, pp. 693–694	145	one hymn per Sunday "that fitteth season and gospel" (table in `hymns.db`)	8.8.6
Wittenberg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1533	1, pp. 704–705	148	German Benedictus first; farced sequences; communion hymns "until the communion is over"; German Te Deum	8.4.3, 8.6.1, 8.8.2, 8.14.2, 8.16.4
Merseburg, *Ordinations-Ordnung*, 1545	2, p. 7	1210	*Veni creator* (Come, Creator) at ordination	8.17.5
Naumburg, St Wenzel, *Kirchen-Ordnung*, 1527	2, p. 60	1218	"Nun bitten" (Now pray we the Holy Ghost) with added stanza; "Aus tiefer Not" (Out of deep distress) for the offertory	8.10.1, 8.11.3
Naumburg, St Wenzel, *Kirchen-Ordnung*, 1537/1538	2, pp. 71–78	1219	three introit-hymns in rotation; troped German Kyries; "All Ehr und Lob" (All honour and praise shall be God's); hymns split around sermon; *Puer natus in Bethlehem* (A child is born in Bethlehem) upon the Magnificat at Christmas	8.5.2, 8.6.4, 8.6.4.1, 8.6.4.2, 8.6.4.3, 8.7.4, 8.8.6, 8.11.6, 8.16.10
Bischofswerda, *Gottesdienst-Ordnung*, printed from a letter of 1676	2, p. 106	1226	festal songs "for the introit" (*Puer natus in Bethlehem*)	8.16.10
Plauen, *Ordnung der Ceremonien*, 1529	2, p. 111	1227	*Salve Jesu Christe*	8.16.5
Schwarzburg and Stolberg, *Ordenunge der religion*, 1549	2, p. 130	1230	people sing the Lord's Prayer hymn	8.13.1
Schwarzburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1574	2, pp. 133, 136	1230	*Leisen* from the pulpit; burial hymn	8.10.2, 8.17.4
Reuss, *Kirchen-Ordnung* of Heinrich IV, 1552	2, pp. 153–154	1234	song for peace after every sermon	8.11.1
Schönburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1542	2, p. 171	1235	"Erhalt uns" (Keep us) in need; no organ at communion; one-hour weekday rule	8.11.1, 8.14.7, 8.18.8
Mansfeld, *Kirchen-Agenda*, 1580	2, pp. 234–238	1241	complaint that Luther's hymns are forgotten; seasonal plan with * for non-Luther hymns; baptism hymns	8.4.2, 8.8.7, 8.17.1, 8.18.5

Order	Sehling	Doc	Hymn practice	§
Henneberg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1582	2, pp. 309–311	1247	prose "Komm, heiliger Geist" (Come, Holy Ghost) to the Latin tune; communion hymns by number; seasonal afternoon hymn	8.4.1, 8.14.2, 8.16.2
Belrieth and Einhausen (Henneberg), 1566	2, p. 330	1248	psalm while people gather	8.4.2
Goldlauter (Henneberg), 1566	2, p. 333	1248	wedding hymns; sixth commandment	8.17.2
Herpf (Henneberg), 1566	2, pp. 334–335	1248	German *Kyrie summum*; Hus's "instructive and comforting" hymn	8.6.4.1, 8.14.1
Meiningen, *Gottesdienst-Ordnungen*, 1562/1566	2, p. 340	1248	Gloria left out in winter	8.7.5
Obermassfeld (Henneberg), 1566	2, p. 343	1249	troped Kyrie "Kyrie, Gott Vater in Ewigkeit" (Kyrie, God the Father in eternity)	8.6.4.1
Queienfeld (Henneberg), 1566	2, pp. 344–345	1249	Hus hymn split around the consecration; catechism hymn held through each part	8.13.2, 8.16.6
Suhl, *Ordnung des predigamts*, 1562	2, p. 351	1250	"Christe du Lamm" to close the communion	8.15.1
Sulzfeld and Klein-Bardorf, 1566	2, pp. 352–353	1250	German Benedictus for introit; festal hymns for introit	8.4.3, 8.5.4
Wasungen (Henneberg), 1566	2, p. 356	1250	three short German Kyries; "Verleih uns Frieden" (Grant us peace) at the end	8.6.4.2, 8.15.5
Halle, *Kirchen-Ordnung*, 1543	2, p. 436	1257	introit-psalms chosen so the people learn them	8.5.6
Aschersleben, *Kirchen-Agenda*, 1575	2, p. 478	1260	credal slot rotated over four Sundays	8.9.1
Cochstedt, *Kirchen-Ordnung*, 1556	2, p. 484	1260	baptism hymn	8.17.1
Anhalt, *Kirchen-Ordnung*, 1548	2, p. 554	1262	psalm while communicants go into the choir	8.11.4
Anhalt, *Ordnung der deutschen Gesänge*, before 1551	2, pp. 555–556	1262	German hymns "woven into" sequences; seasonal hymns for three slots; Trinity hymns kept four Sundays	8.8.3, 8.8.7, 8.11.6
Harzgerode, *Kirchenordnunge*, 1534 (?)	2, p. 586	1263	Latin and German Gloria by turns; farced sequences	8.7.2, 8.8.3

Franconia, Nürnberg, Nördlingen, the Upper Palatinate and Regensburg

Order	Sehling	Doc	Hymn practice	§
Nürnberg, Döber's German Mass in the New Hospital, 1525	11, p. 56	250	"Nun bitten" printed as the introit	8.5.3
Brandenburg-Nürnberg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1533, later appendix	11, p. 202	270	penitential hymns only for the unrepentant dead	8.17.4

Order	Sehling	Doc	Hymn practice	§
Brandenburg-Ansbach, *Ordnung singens und lesens bei den Stiften*, 1533	11, p. 316	276	*O crux ave* cut	8.16.1
Brandenburg-Ansbach, *Auctuarium*, 1548 (Interim order)	11, pp. 329–330	278	pure sequences; psalm-hymns for impure graduals "for the people's sake"; German *Benedicamus* at the end of Mass	8.5.2, 8.8.2, 8.16.8
Hof, *Ordo ecclesiasticus*, 1592	11, pp. 411–475	294	full Sunday table by slot; kneeling "Nun bitten"; communion hymns by number; baptism, wedding and burial hymns; plan defended against changes; *Benedicamus* graded and in German; motets in its place; *Puer natus in Bethlehem* at the entrance to vespers; Latin troped Kyrie in Holy Week; "Heilig ist Gott der Vater" (Holy is God the Father) in four parts at the communion	8.3.1, 8.4.1, 8.6.4.1, 8.6.4.2, 8.6.4.3, 8.6.4.7, 8.8.4, 8.8.8, 8.10.1, 8.12.2, 8.12.4, 8.14.2, 8.15, 8.16.1, 8.16.2, 8.16.7, 8.16.8, 8.16.9, 8.16.10, 8.17.1, 8.17.2, 8.17.4, 8.18.6
Nürnberg, Veit Dietrich, *Agendbüchlein*, 1545	11, p. 502	297	"Als Jesus Christus" (When Jesus Christ, the Son of God) at communion	8.14.6
Schweinfurt, *Kirchenordnung*, 1543	11, p. 641	304	"Erhalt uns" after the sermon	8.11.1
Schweinfurt, *Gottesdienstordnung*, 1576	11, p. 646	304	four-week plan; "Wir glauben" (We believe) for "Nun bitten" in Advent	8.9.4
Weißenburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1528	11, p. 659	308	hymns covering the preacher's going up and coming down	8.10.5, 8.11.2
Wertheim, *Kirchenordnung*, c. 1555	11, p. 716	323	Ten Commandments hymn; "Nun freut euch" (Now rejoice) as a paraphrase of the creed	8.16.6
Nördlingen, *Kirchenordnung* of Kaspar Löner, 1544	12, pp. 311–312	372	"Komm heiliger Geist" (Come, Holy Ghost) / "Nun bitten" graded by feast; "All Ehr und Lob"; hymn while the elements are prepared	8.4.1, 8.7.4, 8.10.1, 8.11.4
Nördlingen, *Ordnung der ceremonien* at St George's, 1555	12, pp. 318–323	373	Gloria left out in Advent; post-epistle list; Sanctus while people gather; freedom clause; "Dank sagen wir alle" (Let us all give thanks to God) for the *Benedicamus* at Christmas; German Kyries by season, after Naumburg	8.6.4, 8.6.4.3, 8.7.5, 8.8.7, 8.12.1, 8.16.9, 8.16.10, 8.18.10
Nördlingen, *Kirchenordnung*, 1579	12, pp. 375–388	375	introit dropped for long psalms and cold; baptism of Christ hymn; thanksgiving day; Latin Kyrie tropes named by their first words	8.5.6, 8.6.4.7, 8.8.7, 8.17.6
Pfalz-Neuburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1543	13, p. 72	386	people sing "Wir glauben" while priest sings the *Credo*	8.9.1
Regensburg, *Wahrhaftiger Bericht*, 1542	13, p. 393	432	Latin Agnus three times; Latin thanksgiving if needed	8.14.2

Order	Sehling	Doc	Hymn practice	§
Regensburg, *Kirchenordnung* of Hieronymus Noppus, 1543	13, pp. 408–410	436	weekday psalm "that the people may learn"; hymns for the dying	8.16.7, 8.17.3
Regensburg, *Kirchenordnung* of Justus Jonas, 1553	13, pp. 419–426	440	Prussian litany and "Erhalt uns" after the epistle; office hymn "if not godless"; "Nun bitten" at an execution	8.8.9, 8.16.1, 8.17.6
Regensburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1567	13, pp. 461–462	450	"Erhalt uns" as "sequence of the season"; penitential psalm after the *Benedicamus*	8.8.9, 8.16.9
Ortenburg, *Gottesdienstordnung*, 1563	13, p. 532	457	the Passion at communion	8.14.6
Rothenberg, *Vereinigung*, 1618	13, p. 550	461	"Gott sei gelobet" as thanksgiving	8.15.2

The Palatinate, Württemberg, Hohenlohe and Swabia

Order	Sehling	Doc	Hymn practice	§
Kurpfalz, provisional *Kirchenordnung*, 1546	14, pp. 96–97	472	pure sequence or tract; *Discubuit* and German *Pange lingua* (Sing, my tongue)	8.8.1, 8.14.5
Kurpfalz, *Kirchenordnung*, 1556 (with 1577 variants)	14, pp. 149, 165	480	songs by teaching and season; minister may stop the singing	8.12.1, 8.14.3, 8.18.2
Hohenlohe, *Kirchenordnung*, 1553	15, pp. 60, 74	539	Latin kept beside German; *Salve Regina* abolished	8.16.5, 8.18.7
Öhringen, *Kirchen- und Schulordnungen*, 1582	15, p. 503	592	hymns to agree with gospel and sermon; last stanza after sermon	8.11.6, 8.18.3
Neuenstein, *Befehle wegen des Gebetsgottesdienstes*, 1588–1594	15, p. 540	604	seven psalm-hymns rotated daily	8.16.7
Langenburg, *Befehl an den Pfarrer*, 1592	15, p. 625	624	dispute over singing only Luther's hymns	8.18.5
Hohenlohe, *Schul- und Gesangsordnung*, 1596	15, pp. 653–657	628	hymns before and after the sermon by twelve doctrinal articles; catechism, wedding, burial and communion hymns; rationale	8.10.4, 8.11.5, 8.16.6, 8.17.2, 8.17.4, 8.18.3
Württemberg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1536	16, pp. 107, 109	651	creed or psalm while pastor goes to altar; hymns examined by superintendents	8.9.3, 8.18.1
Württemberg, *Synodalordnung*, 1547	16, p. 159	660	installation hymns	8.17.5
Württemberg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1553	16, p. 252	671	opening hymn before the sermon	8.3.4
Württemberg, *Hofkirchenordnung*, 1560	16, pp. 427–428	686	choirmaster to follow the season; familiar tune in the tenor	8.18.2, 8.18.9
Limpurg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1610	16, pp. 620, 623	729	communion hymn by season; burial hymn split	8.14.6, 8.17.4

Order	Sehling	Doc	Hymn practice	§
Neckarbischofsheim, *Kirchenordnung*, 1560	16, p. 672	742	*Salve Regina coeli* "turned upon Christ"	8.16.5
Schwäbisch Hall, Brenz, *Kirchenordnung*, 1527	17/1, pp. 49, 51	755	people to learn the German Gloria; Latin and German by turns at communion	8.7.3, 8.14.7
Schwäbisch Hall, *Kirchenordnung*, 1543/1615	17/1, p. 174	763	burial hymn split around sermon	8.17.4
Heilbronn, *Kirchenordnung*, 1530	17/1, pp. 285–286	770	*Pange lingua* Latin and German at communion	8.14.5
Heilbronn, draft *Gottesdienstordnung*, 1532	17/1, pp. 301–302	778	hymn while preacher goes up; German song for the *Salve*	8.10.5, 8.16.5
Heilbronn, *Kirchenordnung*, 1543	17/1, p. 317	781	organ grounded in the Psalms	8.18.9
Heilbronn, *Ordnung des Kirchengesangs*, 1543	17/1, pp. 321–323	782	seasonal office hymns; stanza cut; Te Deum at great communions	8.14.5, 8.16.1, 8.16.2
Reutlingen, *Ordnung der Schule und des Kirchengesangs*, 1565/1566	17/2, pp. 49, 51	828	opening hymn until the preacher is up; "not always the old common fiddle"; list of psalm-hymns	8.4.1, 8.11.5, 8.18.4
Reutlingen, *Artikel der Schulvisitation*, 1574	17/2, p. 58	830	hymn after sermon to fit the text; no repetition	8.11.5
Pfalz-Zweibrücken, *Kirchenordnung*, 1557, songbook	18, pp. 248, 255	968	three German Kyrie-Gloria pairs; no novelty	8.6.4.6, 8.18.6
Pfalz-Zweibrücken, *Ordnung der Kirchengesänge*, 1565	18, pp. 337, 340	985	three-week plan with slot labels; "Nun bitten" every Sunday (table in `hymns.db`); Christmas songs after catechism and sermon	8.3.1, 8.10.1, 8.16.10
Hintere Grafschaft Sponheim, *Kirchen- und Zensurordnung*, 1590/91	18, p. 657	1021	longest hymns before sermon, shortest after; short canon	8.18.4

Hesse, Nassau, the Middle Rhine, Westphalia, Strasbourg

Order	Sehling	Doc	Hymn practice	§
Hessen, *Kirchenordnung*, 1566 (Moderate Reformed)	8, pp. 248, 255	2257	psalms while people gather; Ps 51 for the confession; preach on the sung psalms	8.4.2, 8.4.5, 8.18.4
Hessen, *Agende*, 1574 (Philippist)	8, pp. 411–412, 455	2272	"Komm heiliger Geist" kneeling, with rationale; creed options; *Leisen*; hymn while pastor comes down; language and length rules	8.4.1, 8.9.1, 8.10.2, 8.11.2, 8.17.5, 8.18.7
Hessen-Kassel, *Abschied der Kasseler Generalsynode*, 1607 (Reformed)	9, pp. 75–76	2287	Lobwasser psalms; hymn boards; call for a seasonal and sermon table	8.14.6, 8.18.3
Waldeck, *Kirchenordnung*, 1556	9, p. 273	2300	Lord's Prayer hymn, Ten Commandments and creed before the sermon	8.10.3

Order	Sehling	Doc	Hymn practice	§
Solms-Laubach, *Kirchenordnung* [1576–1580]	9, pp. 359–360	2311	seasonal table before the sermon	8.10.3
Ysenburg-Birstein, *Kirchenordnung*, 1588	10, pp. 620, 628, 632	228	*Leisen* or Lord's Prayer before the sermon; baptism and wedding hymns	8.10.3, 8.17.1, 8.17.2
Worms, *Agendbüchlein*, 1560	19/1, pp. 206, 208	1069	"Nun bitten" or *Leise* (Leise (a vernacular hymn ending Kyrieleis)) before the sermon; no new hymn without superintendent	8.10.2, 8.18.1
Leiningen-Westerburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1566	19/1, p. 267	1074	German hymns at burial instead of the old "singing over"	8.17.4
Sayn, *Kirchenzuchtordnung*, 1582	19/1, p. 369	1090	Latin singing as God's punishment; people to learn the hymns	8.18.4, 8.18.7
Sayn, *Kirchenordnung*, 1590	19/1, p. 407	1090	church sings the Lord's Prayer	8.13.1
Strasbourg, *Ordnung des Herren Nachtmal*, 1525 (Moderate Reformed)	20/1, p. 156	1279	Ps 51 or Ps 130 "in place of the Introit"	8.5.3
Strasbourg, *Gottesdienstordnung*, 1577	20/1, pp. 516, 518	1336	Ps 51 at great communions; no singing, no funeral sermon	8.14.6, 8.17.4
Hanau-Lichtenberg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1573	20/2, p. 54	1364	three rules: season, few hymns, hymn matched to sermon	8.11.5
Herford, *Kirchenordnung*, 1532	21, pp. 176–177	1442	sequences cut and farced; Our Father or "Nun bitten" before sermon	8.8.2, 8.10.1
Dortmund, *Gottesdienstordnung*, 1554	21, pp. 208–209	1446	introit defined as the gathering song; hymn for the offertory	8.4.2, 8.11.3
Lippe, *Kirchenordnung* of Antonius Corvinus [1542]	21, p. 345	1460	Ps 67 or "Dank sagen" (Let us all give thanks to God) while bread and wine are prepared	8.11.3
Lippe, *Kirchenordnung*, 1571	21, pp. 386–396, 438	1462	village Kyrie while people gather; seasonal slot before sermon; catechism hymns; communion hymns	8.4.2, 8.10.3, 8.14.2, 8.16.6, 8.17.5
Wittgenstein, *Kirchenordnung*, 1563	22, pp. 102–103	1493	festal hymns for introits; German Gloria answer; psalm-hymns rotated	8.5.4, 8.7.4, 8.8.8, 8.12.1
Wittgenstein, *Kirchenordnung* [1565]	22, p. 116	1493	"Aus tiefer Not" as a confession	8.4.5
Tecklenburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1543	22, pp. 243–244	1505	German psalm for the introit; thanksgiving hymns to close	8.5.1, 8.15.3
Soest, *Kirchenordnung*, 1532	22, p. 450	1527	three kneeling boys sing *Veni sancte*; psalm while communicants kneel	8.4.1, 8.11.4

Order	Sehling	Doc	Hymn practice	§
Neuenrade, *Kirchenordnung*, 1564	22, pp. 518–519, 527–528, 530–532, 540	1544	Kyrie in three tongues; three German Glorias, "Allein Gott" (To God alone) among them; seasonal post-epistle table; German Agnus; "O Lamm Gottes" (O Lamb of God) in Low German, the third time with the prayer for peace; long *Benedicamus* melodies rejected	8.6.2, 8.7.4, 8.8.7, 8.15, 8.15.1, 8.16.8
Lippe, *Deutsche Messe* [c. 1525–1538]	22, pp. 565–568	1549	"Aus tiefer Not" as introit; early Low German "Allein Gott", all four stanzas; hymn for the offertory	8.5.3, 8.7.3, 8.11.3

Lower Saxony, Bremen and East Frisia

Order	Sehling	Doc	Hymn practice	§
Wolfenbüttel, *Kirchenordnung*, 1543	6/1, pp. 54–59	1972	German Benedictus without organ; "Allein Gott" inside the Latin Gloria; Trinitarian German Sanctus; figured-music limit	8.4.3, 8.6.1, 8.7.1, 8.12.2, 8.14.6, 8.18.8
Wolfenbüttel, *Kirchenordnung*, 1569	6/1, pp. 143, 260–261	1974	Latin for the scholars, German psalm for the people; "Dank sagen wir alle" or *Benedicamus* in the convents	8.8.1, 8.16.9
Braunschweig, Bugenhagen, *Kirchenordnung*, 1528	6/1, pp. 438–442	1983	Greek Kyrie defended; songs to rhyme with the feasts; psalm while communicants go to choir; Latin not forbidden	8.6.3, 8.7.3, 8.9.2, 8.16.3, 8.18.2, 8.18.7
Braunschweig, *Ordnung der ceremonien auf den dorfern*, undated	6/1, p. 473	1988	whole village service in hymns	8.3.3, 8.15.3
Lüneburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1564	6/1, pp. 543–545	2003	litany-hymn after the epistle; baptism there; *Leisen* before the sermon	8.8.9, 8.10.2
Lüneburg, *Reformatio coenobiorum*, 1555	6/1, p. 614	2009	Latin and German Gloria by turns	8.7.2
Lüneburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1575	6/1, pp. 659, 663	2017	creed without organ; *Leisen* as "motet"; deliverance-day hymns	8.9.2, 8.10.2, 8.17.6
Calenberg-Göttingen, *Kirchenordnung*, 1542	6/2, pp. 792–795, 814, 816	2036	village psalm for four chants; hymn "in place of the offertory"; farced sequences; "O Lamm Gottes" after the thanksgiving; German Te Deum	8.5.1, 8.8.3, 8.11.3, 8.15, 8.16.4
Calenberg-Göttingen, *Kirchenordnung*, 1542, the German Masses	6/2, pp. 820–825	2037	German sequences; "Mit Fried und Freud" (With peace and joy I depart) for the gradual; festal *Leise* for the offertory	8.8.4, 8.8.5, 8.11.3, 8.12.1
Northeim, *Kirchenordnung*, 1539	6/2, pp. 924–926	2047	chant while people gather; choice is free; *Da pacem* (Give peace) to close; German Te Deum	8.4.2, 8.8.1, 8.15.3, 8.16.4
Grubenhagen, *Kirchenordnung*, 1581	6/2, pp. 1046, 1048	2058	catechism hymn held through each part; Spangenberg's cantional	8.16.6, 8.18.6
Hoya, *Kirchenordnung*, 1581	6/2, pp. 1148–1151	2065	German Te Deum at opening; *Leisen* in pulpit; festal closing hymns; Luther's hymns first	8.4.4, 8.10.2, 8.15.3, 8.16.6, 8.18.5
Buxtehude, *Kirchenordnung*, 1552	7/1, pp. 70, 74–78	2082	introit kept if scriptural; creed as offertory without organ; organist to follow the choir; seasonal hymn before the sermon	8.5.1, 8.9.2, 8.10.1, 8.15.3, 8.18.1, 8.18.9

Order	Sehling	Doc	Hymn practice	§
Buxtehude, *Agende*, 1565	7/1, p. 123	2082	Kyrie of the highest feasts "with the text"; texts left out by the editor	8.6.4.7
Verden, *Kirchenordnung*, 1606	7/1, pp. 155–158	2090	*Veni sancte* at the altar; gospel-matched psalm; *Leisen*; hymn while preacher vests	8.4.1, 8.8.6, 8.10.2, 8.11.2
Osnabrück (Stift), *Kirchenordnung*, 1543	7/1, pp. 224–225	2096	creed after the sermon; wedding Te Deum and Ps 128	8.9.2, 8.17.2
Osnabrück (city), *Kirchenordnung*, 1543	7/1, p. 258	2099	"Allein Gott" inside the Latin Gloria	8.7.1
Ostfriesland, *Kirchenordnung*, 1535	7/1, pp. 376, 380	2107	Kyrie and Gloria as in "Allein Gott"; Latin kept in honour; German psalm in place of the *Benedicamus*	8.6.5, 8.16.9, 8.18.7
Engerhafe, *Liturgie*, 1583	7/1, pp. 677–681	2119	offertory hymn with organ; "O Lamm Gottes" split across the rite; communion hymns	8.11.3, 8.13.2, 8.14.6
Marienhafe, *Kirchenordnung*, 1593	7/1, pp. 695, 697	2120	Kyrie "Ach Vater" (Ah Father) and Te Deum at opening; hymn agreeing with the sermon	8.4.4, 8.6.4.4, 8.11.5
Harlingerland, *Kirchenordnung*, 1573/74	7/1, pp. 738–739	2122	Luther's hymns first; no secular tunes; kneeling boys at the Sanctus; "Heilig ist Gott der Vater" among the communion hymns	8.12.2, 8.18.5, 8.18.9
Hildesheim (Stift), *Kirchenordnung für Steuerwald und Peine*, 1561	7/2.1, pp. 781–783	2129	German Te Deum at opening; *Leisen*; closing hymn	8.4.4, 8.10.2, 8.15.3
Hildesheim (city), *Kirchenordnung*, 1544	7/2.1, pp. 852–856	2136	hymn covering the prayers at the step and the devesting; Latin for the school	8.4.6, 8.15.4, 8.16.3
Oldenburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1573	7/2.1, pp. 1085–1089	2149	sexton among the people for the German *Et in terra* (And on earth); cantionals; "unfalsified" Luther songbook	8.7.3, 8.18.6
Goslar, Amsdorf, *Vom teglichen gots dinst*, 1528	7/2.2, pp. 237–238	2187	burial singing left to the pastor	8.17.4
Goslar, SS. Simon and Jude, *Neugestaltung des Gottesdienstes*, 1560	7/2.2, p. 320	2204	people sing while they gather for the sermon	8.4.2
Bremen, *Kirchenordnung*, 1534	7/2.2, pp. 460–464	2217	hymns until the last bell; creed as offertory; *O sacrum convivium* (O sacred banquet); organ as a trumpet	8.4.2, 8.9.2, 8.14.5, 8.18.9
Bremen, *Kirchenordnung*, 1561	7/2.2, pp. 510, 513	2221	German songs until the people gather; Hus hymn in the old melody	8.4.2, 8.14.1

Schleswig-Holstein, Hamburg, Lauenburg and Hadeln, Mecklenburg, Livonia

Order	Sehling	Doc	Hymn practice	§
Schleswig-Holstein, *Deutsche Messe* [after 1526]	23, pp. 56–57	1576	troped Low German Kyrie; stanzas of "Jesus Christus" (Jesus Christ [our Saviour]) between the actions	8.6.4.5, 8.14.4

Order	Sehling	Doc	Hymn practice	§
Hadersleben, *Artikel*, 1528	23, p. 64	1576	Latin sequences "with the *Leisen* in them"	8.8.3
Schleswig-Holstein, *Kirchenordnung*, 1542	23, pp. 89–95, 143, 146	1576	German psalm for introit in villages; "Allein Gott" inside the Latin Gloria; three sequences only; song stops with the communion; *O crux ave* condemned; Michaelmas Te Deum	8.5.1, 8.7.1, 8.8.2, 8.14.3, 8.16.1, 8.17.6
Hamburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1529	5, pp. 491, 516–530	1958, 1960	"for the people's sake"; introits and joyful songs; farced sequences; creed as offertory; German Agnus; "Of singing"; wedding music	8.3.4, 8.5.4, 8.8.3, 8.9.2, 8.14.4, 8.15.1, 8.16.3, 8.17.2, 8.18.1
Hamburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1556	5, p. 553	1963	organ between the verses; choir stops with the communion; *Da pacem* to close	8.14.3, 8.15.3
Ritzebüttel, *Kirchenordnung*, 1556	5, pp. 557–558	1963	prose "Komm heiliger Geist" for the introit; three German Kyries; the people finish the German Gloria; "Erhalt uns" after sermon	8.5.5, 8.6.4.4, 8.6.4.5, 8.7.4, 8.11.1
Lauenburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1585	5, p. 408	1953	installation hymns	8.17.5
Hadeln, *Kirchenordnung*, 1526	5, p. 468	1955	creed and psalm covering the preacher's movements	8.9.3, 8.11.2
Mecklenburg, *Ordeninge der misse*, 1545	5, pp. 151–155	1922	*Leise* as introit; German *Kyrie summum* taught to villages; organ-farced sequences; gospel-matched psalms; Sanctus forms; kneeling close	8.5.4, 8.6.4.4, 8.8.3, 8.8.6, 8.11.5, 8.12.2, 8.14.3, 8.15, 8.15.3
Mecklenburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1552	5, pp. 199–201	1922	*Leisen* from the pulpit; "Christe du Lamm" to close; hymns "that they may become known"	8.10.2, 8.15.1, 8.18.4
Rostock, *Conformitas ceremoniarum*, c. 1560	5, pp. 288–290	1936	psalm agreeing with the gospel; "Help Gott" (Help, God) at communion; Lossius and one melody	8.11.5, 8.14.6, 8.17.4, 8.18.6
Riga, *Kirchenordnung*, 1530	5, pp. 15, 17	1897	Latin or German introit; Kyrie in three tongues; Lord's Prayer hymn at weekday communion	8.5.1, 8.6.2, 8.13.1
Kurland, *Kirchenordnung*, 1570	5, pp. 88, 91, 105	1907	litany-hymn after the epistle; *Leisen* intoned in the pulpit; catechism hymns for Latvians; burial hymns	8.8.9, 8.10.2, 8.16.6, 8.17.4

Brandenburg, Silesia, Prussia, Pomerania, Poland, Transylvania

Order	Sehling	Doc	Hymn practice	§
Brandenburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1540	3, pp. 69–81	1746	hymn at the elevation; village psalm for the offertory; *Discubuit* and German hymns; burial hymns by the course of the procession	8.11.3, 8.12.3, 8.14.5, 8.17.4
Brandenburg, *Visitations- und Consistorialordnung*, 1573	3, p. 109	1748	installation hymns	8.17.5
Tangermünde, *Ritus*, 1603	3, p. 339	1788	Christmas *Leise* until Candlemas	8.10.3
Liegnitz, *Kirchenordnung*, 1542	3, p. 439	1809	creed after the sermon	8.9.2

Order	Sehling	Doc	Hymn practice	§
Brieg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1592	3, pp. 445–446	1809	Athanasian creed from Triller; hymns to agree with sermon, but known hymns not put under; Magnificat with *Resonet in laudibus* (Let it resound in praises)	8.9.1, 8.10.4, 8.11.4, 8.16.10
Teschen, *Kirchenordnung*, 1584	3, p. 462	1815	German or Bohemian hymn for the introit	8.5.1
Prussia, *Artikel der Ceremonien*, 1525	4, pp. 32–33	1832	German psalms for introits; Kyrie in three tongues; Hus hymn and "Gott sei gelobet"	8.5.1, 8.6.2, 8.14.1
Prussia, *Kirchenordnung*, 1544	4, pp. 64–65	1833	rotating introit-psalms; alleluia and psalm list; hymn while priest "takes breath"; Sanctus while communicants come forward	8.5.2, 8.8.7, 8.11.2, 8.12.1
Prussia, *Kirchenordnung und Ceremonien*, 1568	4, pp. 75–84	1833	Latin and German Gloria by turns; farced sequences; "Nun bitten" before, "Erhalt uns" after every sermon; Luther's hymns first	8.7.2, 8.8.3, 8.9.1, 8.10.1, 8.11.1, 8.18.5
Danzig, *Kirchenordnung*, 1557, in Sehling's summary	4, p. 168	1844	same hymns two Sundays running	8.18.4
Thorn, *Kirchenordnung*, 1575	4, p. 237	1844	hymn before sermon by text and need	8.10.4
Pomerania, *Kirchenordnung*, 1535	4, pp. 340–344	1856	German Benedictus; Ten Commandments or *Da pacem* while communicants gather; song stops with communion; against long singing	8.4.3, 8.11.4, 8.14.3, 8.18.8
Pomerania, *Kirchenordnung*, 1542	4, p. 356	1859	Ps 51 for introit; lay "Allein Gott"; gospel-matched psalms; seasonal slot before sermon	8.5.2, 8.7.2, 8.8.6, 8.10.3
Pomerania, *Kerckenordeninge*, 1569	4, pp. 401–402	1862	old festal songs, Latin and German, taught in the schools	8.16.10
Pomerania, *Agenda*, 1569	4, pp. 435–440	1865	Te Deum for village introit; both German Glorias; gospel-matched psalm; Lossius; boys intone the Sanctus; organ at communion; closing hymns (table in `hymns.db`); *Benedicamus* by grade; *Da pacem* after it	8.4.4, 8.5.2, 8.7.2, 8.8.6, 8.12.1, 8.14.7, 8.15.3, 8.16.2, 8.16.8, 8.16.9, 8.16.10
Stralsund, draft *Kirchenordnung*, 1555	4, p. 551	1889	two German Sanctus forms	8.12.2
Kronstadt, Honterus, *Reformationsbüchlein*, 1543	24, p. 183	1666	German songs after the epistle "if not repugnant to Scripture"	8.8.1
Transylvanian Saxons, *Kirchenordnung*, 1547	24, pp. 223–245	1669	German Benedictus for the abolished procession; hymn before the sermon by season; office hymns of the season only	8.4.3, 8.10.3, 8.16.1

Appendix 8.A The chief hymn (*Hauptlied*) of each Sunday and feast in the old sources

This appendix condenses the **Compare by day** sheet of `hymns.xlsx`. That sheet lists every hymn that any witness in `hymns.db` assigns to a day, with the number of witnesses for each. Here the same evidence is cut down in two ways, so that the hymn of each day can be read at a glance:

- **Only the old sources are counted.** These are the church orders and hymnals of 1543–1694, the Leipzig usage of Bach's time, and the modern studies that do nothing but collate those older sources. The modern lists, from 1800 onward, are

left out.

- **Only the hymns with significant support are given.** A day with one clear hymn shows that hymn alone. A day where support is divided shows each hymn with good support, and none of the hymns with only a few witnesses.

The word *Hauptlied* is later terminology and does not occur in the corpus (see §8.8 and the Introduction, The hymn database). The tables these witnesses keep are tables for the hymn of the day, which the orders place between the epistle and the gospel (§8.8.7) or before the sermon (§8.10.3).

8.A.1 The witnesses counted

Of the 50 witnesses in `hymns.db`, 29 are counted as old.

Group	Witnesses
Sehling church orders (8)	Heilbronn 1543; Pfalz-Zweibrücken 1565; Pomerania, *Agenda*, 1569; Weissenfels 1578; Nördlingen 1579; Mansfeld 1580; Hof 1592; Hohenlohe 1596
Hymnals collated in Liliencron's *de tempore* (of the season) concordance (15)	Spangenberg 1545; Keuchenthal 1573; Selnecker; Gesius 1601; Leipzig *Geistliche Lieder* 1605; Stiphelius 1607; Augsburg 1619; Liegnitz 1625–30; Helmstedt 1626; Schein 1627; Erhardi, Frankfurt 1659; Schleswig-Holstein 1665; Darmstadt 1687; Goslar 1687; Leipzig *Kirchenandachten* 1694
Other single orders and schemes (4)	Ludecus, *Ordo cantionum Germanicarum*, 1589; Carpzov (the hymns on which he preached); the *de tempore* plan of c. 1700 printed by Graff; Bach's Leipzig usage (the chorales of his Sunday and festival cantatas)
Modern studies that collate older sources (2)	Stiller (the Leipzig, Weissenfels and Dresden hymn schedules of Bach's time); Thompson, dissertation, Appendix 2 (Ludecus with twelve other 16th-century lists)

The other 21 witnesses are modern and are **not counted**. Krusemark explains his own lists on pp. 95–96 of `Hymns_ABC_Krusemark.pdf`. The modern witnesses are:

- Krusemark's own series: Years A, B and C, and, on the days the three-year series does not cover, a list for every year or one each for even and odd years;
- the lists of Stuckwisch, Reuning, Gehrke, Eckardt, Judisch, Zion (Detroit) and Redeemer;
- the LCMS Synod selections of 2016–17 and the LSB Hymnal Committee;
- *Lutheran Worship* (1982), *Lutheran Service Book* (2006) and the SELK hymnal;
- the Mecklenburg hymnal of 1855;
- two private schemes (MC, SD).

Some of the old witnesses reach `hymns.db` through modern compilations. Carpzov, Bach and the plan of c. 1700 come through Krusemark or the Hymn of the Day table, and Selnecker through all three. Each is counted once, as a witness, whichever book it was read from (Introduction, The hymn database).

Some of the old witnesses add nothing to the table, for these reasons:

- **Pfalz-Zweibrücken 1565.** Its table is a three-week rotating cycle, not tied to particular Sundays, so it falls outside this table.
- **Heilbronn 1543, Nördlingen 1579 and Hof 1592.** They assign Latin office hymns. These count among the witnesses for their days but never reach the threshold.

8.A.2 How the table was made

- **Counting is by witness.** A hymn's figure is the number of old witnesses that assign it to the day. "11 of 18" means that 11 of the 18 old witnesses that give any hymn for that day give this one.

- **One hymn, one row.** Spellings, Low German forms and English titles of the same hymn are joined, as in the workbook. English-only citations from Carpzov, Selnecker, Bach, the plan of c. 1700 and Thompson are joined to their German hymns. "The Day Is Surely Drawing Near", for example, is joined to *Es ist gewisslich an der Zeit* (It is surely time). The hymn

database does this joining with its lexicon of hymns and its table of English titles, so `hymns.db` and the workbook group the hymns as this table does.

- **Hymns with the same or a similar opening are kept apart:**
  - Eber's *Herr Gott, dich loben alle wir* (Lord God, we all praise thee), on the angels, is kept apart from Luther's German Te Deum *Herr Gott, dich loben wir* (Lord God, we praise thee). Liliencron himself insists on this distinction.
  - Luther's Easter hymn *Jesus Christus, unser Heiland, der den Tod überwand* (Jesus Christ, our Saviour, who overcame death) is kept apart from his Communion hymn of the same opening. A source that prints only the opening words for an Easter occasion is read as meaning the Easter hymn.
  - *Als Jesus Christus, Gottes Sohn* (When Jesus Christ, the Son of God) is kept apart from *Jesus Christus, wahrer Gottes Sohn* (Jesus Christ, true Son of God).
  - *Mag ich dem Tod nicht widerstahn* (Though I cannot withstand death) is kept apart from *Mag ich Unglück nicht widerstahn* (If I cannot withstand misfortune).

- **Grouped entries are shared out.** An entry for "Lent 1–3" or "Lent 5, Palm Sunday and Good Friday" counts for each of the days it names. The last Sundays after Trinity are given together, as most of the hymnals give them ("Trinity 25–27"). Entries for a whole season ("Advent", "Lent", "Easter season") and the Pfalz-Zweibrücken cycle are not counted.

- **Which hymns are shown.** A hymn is shown for a day when it meets all three of these conditions:
  - it has at least three witnesses;
  - it has at least three fifths of the witnesses of the day's leading hymn;
  - it has at least a quarter of the witnesses that give any hymn for that day.

  On Advent 1, *Nun komm, der Heiden Heiland* (Now come, Savior of the heathen) has 20 witnesses and no other hymn more than 7, so it stands alone. On Advent 2, *Gott hat das Evangelium* (God has given the gospel) (11), *Es ist gewisslich an der Zeit* (8) and *Ihr lieben Christen, freut euch nun* (Ye dear Christians, rejoice now) (8) are shown. *Es wird schier der letzte Tag herkommen* (The last day will soon be coming) (6), *Ach Gott, thu dich erbarmen* (Ah God, have mercy) (5) and *Nun komm* (Now come, Savior of the heathen) (4) are not.

- **Days the witnesses leave open.** On Quasimodogeniti, Maundy Thursday, Easter Monday and Pentecost Monday no hymn has three old witnesses. For these four days the table gives the hymn assigned by the editor of the corpus, marked ‡, with the number of old witnesses that do give it. The assignments are kept in a table of their own in `hymns.db`, and flagged "Assigned" in the Compare by day sheet. They are not prescriptions and are not counted as witnesses.

- **Titles.**
  - **Original title:** the hymn's standard spelling from the `hymns` lexicon.
  - **Literal English:** a word-for-word rendering of the incipit.
  - **Common English title:** the received English title. Where the hymn has none, the title of Matthew Carver's translation is given and marked †. These come from *Walther's Hymnal* (2012), which Carver translated, or from his blog *Hymnoglypt* (Introduction, The hymn database). The title is "—" where neither exists.

8.A.3 The table

Sunday or feast	Original title	Literal English	Common English title	Witnesses
Advent 1	*Nun komm, der Heiden Heiland* (Now come, Savior of the heathen)	Now come, Savior of the heathen	Savior of the Nations, Come	20 of 23
Advent 2	*Gott hat das Evangelium* (God has given the gospel)	God has given the gospel	God Gave the Gospel That We May †	11 of 18
	Es ist gewisslich an der Zeit (It is surely time)	It is surely time	The Day Is Surely Drawing Near	8 of 18

Sunday or feast	Original title	Literal English	Common English title	Witnesses
	Ihr lieben Christen, freut euch nun (Ye dear Christians, rejoice now)	Ye dear Christians, rejoice now	Rejoice, Rejoice, Ye Christians Dear †	8 of 18
Advent 3	*Herr Christ, der einig Gotts Sohn* (Lord Christ, the only Son of God)	Lord Christ, the only Son of God	The Only Son from Heaven	11 of 18
	Nun komm, der Heiden Heiland	Now come, Savior of the heathen	Savior of the Nations, Come	9 of 18
Advent 4	*Herr Christ, der einig Gotts Sohn*	Lord Christ, the only Son of God	The Only Son from Heaven	11 of 15
	Christ, unser Herr, zum Jordan kam (Christ our Lord came to the Jordan)	Christ our Lord came to the Jordan	To Jordan Came the Christ, Our Lord	7 of 15
Christmas Day	*Gelobet seist du, Jesu Christ* (Praised be thou, Jesus Christ)	Praised be thou, Jesus Christ	All Praise to Thee, Eternal Lord	20 of 25
	Christum wir sollen loben schon (Christ we should indeed praise)	Christ we should indeed praise	Now Praise We Christ, the Holy One	17 of 25
	Vom Himmel hoch da komm ich her (From heaven high I come here)	From heaven high I come here	From Heaven Above to Earth I Come	17 of 25
	Der Tag, der ist so freudenreich (The day that is so full of joy)	The day that is so full of joy	Hail This Joyous Day	16 of 25
	Vom Himmel kam der Engel Schar (From heaven came the host of angels)	From heaven came the host of angels	To Shepherds as They Watched by Night	15 of 25
	In dulci jubilo (In sweet rejoicing)	In sweet rejoicing	Good Christian Men, Rejoice	13 of 25
Sunday after Christmas	*Herr Christ, der einig Gotts Sohn*	Lord Christ, the only Son of God	The Only Son from Heaven	4 of 10
	Hilf Gott, wie geht das immer zu (Help God, how does this ever go on)	Help God, how does this ever go on	Oh, Help Us, God! Why Must It Be †	4 of 10
	Wo Gott der Herr nicht bei uns hält (If God the Lord does not stand by us)	If God the Lord does not stand by us	If God Had Not Been on Our Side	3 of 10
New Year (Circumcision)	*Helft mir Gotts Güte preisen* (Help me praise God's goodness)	Help me praise God's goodness	To God the Anthem Raising †	8 of 15
	Das alte Jahr vergangen ist (The old year has passed)	The old year has passed	The Old Year Now Hath Passed Away	6 of 15
Sunday after New Year	*Wo Gott der Herr nicht bei uns hält*	If God the Lord does not stand by us	If God Had Not Been on Our Side	3 of 3
Epiphany	*Was fürchtst du, Feind Herodes, sehr* (Why dost thou fear so, foe Herod)	Why dost thou fear so, foe Herod	Why, Herod, Unrelenting Foe	18 of 24

Sunday or feast	Original title	Literal English	Common English title	Witnesses
Epiphany 1	*Dies sind die heilgen zehn Gebot* (These are the holy ten commandments)	These are the holy ten commandments	These Are the Holy Ten Commands	13 of 17
	Mensch, willst du leben seliglich (Man, wouldst thou live blessedly)	Man, wouldst thou live blessedly	Man, Wouldst Thou Live All Blissfully	8 of 17
Epiphany 2	*Wohl dem, der in Gottes Furcht steht* (Blessed is he who stands in the fear of God)	Blessed is he who stands in the fear of God	Blessed Are They Who Fear the Lord	13 of 17
Epiphany 3	*Ich ruf zu dir, Herr Jesu Christ* (I call to thee, Lord Jesus Christ)	I call to thee, Lord Jesus Christ	I Call to Thee, Lord Jesus Christ	7 of 16
Epiphany 4	*Wo Gott der Herr nicht bei uns hält*	If God the Lord does not stand by us	If God Had Not Been on Our Side	11 of 18
	Wär Gott nicht mit uns diese Zeit (Were God not with us at this time)	Were God not with us at this time	Were God Not with Us at This Time	8 of 18
Epiphany 5	*Ach Gott, vom Himmel sieh darein* (O God, look down from heaven)	O God, look down from heaven	O Lord, Look Down from Heaven, Behold	10 of 15
Epiphany 6	*Herr Christ, der einig Gotts Sohn*	Lord Christ, the only Son of God	The Only Son from Heaven	7 of 11
	Es wolle Gott uns gnädig sein (May God be gracious to us)	May God be gracious to us	May God Bestow on Us His Grace	5 of 11
Septuagesima	*Es ist das Heil uns kommen her* (Salvation has come to us)	Salvation has come to us	Salvation unto Us Has Come	14 of 23
Sexagesima	*Ach Gott, vom Himmel sieh darein*	O God, look down from heaven	O Lord, Look Down from Heaven, Behold	7 of 19
	Es spricht der Unweisen Mund wohl (The mouth of the unwise says indeed)	The mouth of the unwise says indeed	The Mouth of Fools Doth God Confess	7 of 19
	Kommt her zu mir, spricht Gottes Sohn (Come here to me, says God's Son)	Come here to me, says God's Son	Come unto Me, Ye Weary	6 of 19
	Es ist das Heil uns kommen her	Salvation has come to us	Salvation unto Us Has Come	5 of 19
Quinquagesima (Estomihi)	*Durch Adams Fall ist ganz verderbt* (Through Adam's fall all is wholly corrupted)	Through Adam's fall all is wholly corrupted	All Mankind Fell in Adam’s Fall	3 of 9
	Herr Jesu Christ, wahr Mensch und Gott (Lord Jesus Christ, true man and God)	Lord Jesus Christ, true man and God	Lord Jesus Christ, True Man and God	3 of 9
Lent 1 (Invocavit)	*Ein feste Burg ist unser Gott* (A mighty fortress is our God)	A firm fortress is our God	A Mighty Fortress Is Our God	16 of 20

Sunday or feast	Original title	Literal English	Common English title	Witnesses
	Gott der Vater wohn uns bei (God the Father, dwell with us)	God the Father, dwell with us	God the Father, Be Our Stay	12 of 20
	Christe, der du bist Tag und Licht (Christ, thou who art day and light)	Christ, thou who art day and light	O Christ, Who Art the Light and Day	11 of 20
Lent 2 (Reminiscere)	*Ich ruf zu dir, Herr Jesu Christ*	I call to thee, Lord Jesus Christ	I Call to Thee, Lord Jesus Christ	11 of 16
	Gott der Vater wohn uns bei	God the Father, dwell with us	God the Father, Be Our Stay	8 of 16
	Christe, der du bist Tag und Licht	Christ, thou who art day and light	O Christ, Who Art the Light and Day	7 of 16
	Ein feste Burg ist unser Gott	A firm fortress is our God	A Mighty Fortress Is Our God	7 of 16
Lent 3 (Oculi)	*Ein feste Burg ist unser Gott*	A firm fortress is our God	A Mighty Fortress Is Our God	14 of 18
	Gott der Vater wohn uns bei	God the Father, dwell with us	God the Father, Be Our Stay	10 of 18
Lent 4 (Laetare)	*Vater unser im Himmelreich* (Our Father in the kingdom of heaven)	Our Father in the kingdom of heaven	Our Father, Thou in Heaven Above	6 of 17
	Warum betrübst du dich, mein Herz (Why art thou troubled, my heart)	Why art thou troubled, my heart	Why Art Thou Thus Cast Down, My Heart	6 of 17
	Durch Adams Fall ist ganz verderbt	Through Adam's fall all is wholly corrupted	All Mankind Fell in Adam’s Fall	5 of 17
	O Mensch, bewein dein Sünde groß (O man, bewail thy great sin)	O man, bewail thy great sin	O Man, Bewail Thy Grievous Sin	5 of 17
Lent 5 (Judica)	*Christus, der uns selig macht* (Christ, who makes us blessed)	Christ, who makes us blessed	Christ, Who Saves Us by His Cross †	4 of 14
	Da Jesus an dem Kreuze stund (When Jesus on the cross stood)	When Jesus on the cross stood	When Jesus on the Cross Was Bound	4 of 14
	O Lamm Gottes, unschuldig (O Lamb of God, innocent)	O Lamb of God, innocent	Lamb of God, Pure and Holy	4 of 14
	Wo Gott der Herr nicht bei uns hält	If God the Lord does not stand by us	If God Had Not Been on Our Side	4 of 14
Palm Sunday	*Christus, der uns selig macht*	Christ, who makes us blessed	Christ, Who Saves Us by His Cross †	5 of 16
	Hilf Gott, dass mir gelinge (Help, God, that I may succeed)	Help, God, that I may succeed	Assist Me, Great Creator †	5 of 16
	Nun freut euch, lieben Christen gmein (Now rejoice, dear Christians together)	Now rejoice, dear Christians together	Dear Christians, One and All, Rejoice	4 of 16

Sunday or feast	Original title	Literal English	Common English title	Witnesses
Maundy Thursday	*Jesus Christus, unser Heiland* (Jesus Christ, our Saviour)	Jesus Christ, our Savior	Jesus Christ, Our Blessed Savior	2 of 3 ‡
Good Friday	*Da Jesus an dem Kreuze stund*	When Jesus on the cross stood	When Jesus on the Cross Was Bound	10 of 12
	Christus, der uns selig macht	Christ, who makes us blessed	Christ, Who Saves Us by His Cross †	6 of 12
Easter Day	*Christ ist erstanden* (Christ is arisen)	Christ is risen	Christ Is Arisen	18 of 22
	Christ lag in Todesbanden (Christ lay in death's bonds)	Christ lay in death's bonds	Christ Jesus Lay in Death's Strong Bands	16 of 22
	Jesus Christus, unser Heiland, der den Tod überwand (Jesus Christ, our Saviour, who overcame death)	Jesus Christ, our Saviour, who overcame death	Jesus Christ, Our Savior and King †	15 of 22
	Erstanden ist der heilige Christ (The holy Christ is risen)	The holy Christ is risen	—	14 of 22
Easter Monday	*Ach bleib bei uns, Herr Jesu Christ* (Abide with us, Lord Jesus Christ)	Abide with us, Lord Jesus Christ	Lord Jesus Christ, with Us Abide	1 of 2 ‡
	Christ ist erstanden	Christ is risen	Christ Is Arisen	1 of 2 ‡
Easter 1 (Quasimodogeniti)	*O filii et filiae* (O sons and daughters)	O sons and daughters	O Sons and Daughters of the King	0 of 5 ‡
Easter 2 (Misericordias Domini)	*Der Herr ist mein getreuer Hirt* (The Lord is my faithful shepherd)	The Lord is my faithful shepherd	The Lord's My Shepherd, Faithful, True	11 of 14
Easter 3 (Jubilate)	*Kommt her zu mir, spricht Gottes Sohn*	Come here to me, says God's Son	Come unto Me, Ye Weary	9 of 13
	Mag ich Unglück nicht widerstahn (If I cannot withstand misfortune)	If I cannot withstand misfortune	May I My Fate No More Withstand †	6 of 13
Easter 4 (Cantate)	*Nun freut euch, lieben Christen gmein*	Now rejoice, dear Christians together	Dear Christians, One and All, Rejoice	11 of 14
Easter 5 (Rogate)	*Vater unser im Himmelreich*	Our Father in the kingdom of heaven	Our Father, Thou in Heaven Above	16 of 17
Ascension	*Christ fuhr gen Himmel* (Christ went up to heaven)	Christ went up to heaven	Christ Went Up to Heaven	17 of 23
	Nun freut euch, lieben Christen gmein	Now rejoice, dear Christians together	Dear Christians, One and All, Rejoice	11 of 23
Sunday after Ascension (Exaudi)	*Wo Gott der Herr nicht bei uns hält*	If God the Lord does not stand by us	If God Had Not Been on Our Side	12 of 13
Pentecost	*Komm, Heiliger Geist, Herre Gott* (Come, Holy Ghost, Lord God)	Come, Holy Spirit, Lord God	Come, Holy Ghost, God and Lord	21 of 23

Sunday or feast	Original title	Literal English	Common English title	Witnesses
	Nun bitten wir den Heiligen Geist (Now pray we the Holy Ghost)	Now we pray to the Holy Spirit	We Now Implore God the Holy Ghost	19 of 23
	Komm, Gott Schöpfer, Heiliger Geist (Come, God Creator, Holy Spirit)	Come, God Creator, Holy Spirit	Come, Holy Ghost, Creator Blest	13 of 23
Pentecost Monday	*Komm, Heiliger Geist, Herre Gott*	Come, Holy Spirit, Lord God	Come, Holy Ghost, God and Lord	1 of 2 ‡
Trinity Sunday	*Gott der Vater wohn uns bei*	God the Father, dwell with us	God the Father, Be Our Stay	21 of 24
Trinity 1	*Es war einmal ein reicher Mann* (There was once a rich man)	There was once a rich man	There Was a Rich and Wealthy Man †	11 of 19
Trinity 2	*Ach Gott, vom Himmel sieh darein*	O God, look down from heaven	O Lord, Look Down from Heaven, Behold	13 of 22
	Es spricht der Unweisen Mund wohl	The mouth of the unwise says indeed	The Mouth of Fools Doth God Confess	13 of 22
	Es wolle Gott uns gnädig sein	May God be gracious to us	May God Bestow on Us His Grace	8 of 22
Trinity 3	*Erbarm dich mein, o Herre Gott* (Have mercy on me, O Lord God)	Have mercy on me, O Lord God	Have Mercy on Me, O Lord God	12 of 19
	Allein zu dir, Herr Jesu Christ (In thee alone, Lord Jesus Christ)	In thee alone, Lord Jesus Christ	In Thee Alone, O Christ, My Lord	8 of 19
Trinity 4	*Dies sind die heilgen zehn Gebot*	These are the holy ten commandments	These Are the Holy Ten Commands	15 of 21
	Mensch, willst du leben seliglich	Man, wouldst thou live blessedly	Man, Wouldst Thou Live All Blissfully	9 of 21
Trinity 5	*Wo Gott zum Haus nicht gibt sein Gunst* (If God does not give his favour to the house)	If God does not give his favour to the house	Unless the Lord Builds Up the House	12 of 20
Trinity 6	*Es ist das Heil uns kommen her*	Salvation has come to us	Salvation unto Us Has Come	19 of 21
	Durch Adams Fall ist ganz verderbt	Through Adam's fall all is wholly corrupted	All Mankind Fell in Adam’s Fall	12 of 21
Trinity 7	*Vater unser im Himmelreich*	Our Father in the kingdom of heaven	Our Father, Thou in Heaven Above	12 of 21
	Warum betrübst du dich, mein Herz	Why art thou troubled, my heart	Why Art Thou Thus Cast Down, My Heart	12 of 21

Sunday or feast	Original title	Literal English	Common English title	Witnesses
	Wohl dem, der in Gottes Furcht steht	Blessed is he who stands in the fear of God	Blessed Are They Who Fear the Lord	8 of 21
Trinity 8	*Ach Gott, vom Himmel sieh darein*	O God, look down from heaven	O Lord, Look Down from Heaven, Behold	19 of 22
Trinity 9	*Es wolle Gott uns gnädig sein*	May God be gracious to us	May God Bestow on Us His Grace	8 of 21
	Dies sind die heilgen zehn Gebot	These are the holy ten commandments	These Are the Holy Ten Commands	6 of 21
	Herr Christ, der einig Gotts Sohn	Lord Christ, the only Son of God	The Only Son from Heaven	6 of 21
	Weltlich Ehr und zeitlich Gut (Worldly honour and temporal goods)	Worldly honour and temporal goods	—	6 of 21
Trinity 10	*An Wasserflüssen Babylon*	By the waters of Babylon	By the Waters of Babylon	17 of 21
Trinity 11	*Aus tiefer Not schrei ich zu dir* (Out of deep distress I cry to thee)	Out of deep distress I cry to thee	From Depths of Woe I Cry to Thee	14 of 22
	Allein zu dir, Herr Jesu Christ	In thee alone, Lord Jesus Christ	In Thee Alone, O Christ, My Lord	12 of 22
	Erbarm dich mein, o Herre Gott	Have mercy on me, O Lord God	Have Mercy on Me, O Lord God	10 of 22
	Es ist das Heil uns kommen her	Salvation has come to us	Salvation unto Us Has Come	9 of 22
Trinity 12	*Nun lob, mein Seel, den Herren* (Now praise the Lord, my soul)	Now praise the Lord, my soul	My Soul, Now Praise Thy Maker	12 of 19
Trinity 13	*Es ist das Heil uns kommen her*	Salvation has come to us	Salvation unto Us Has Come	17 of 19
Trinity 14	*Nun lob, mein Seel, den Herren*	Now praise the Lord, my soul	My Soul, Now Praise Thy Maker	12 of 17
	Erbarm dich mein, o Herre Gott	Have mercy on me, O Lord God	Have Mercy on Me, O Lord God	8 of 17
Trinity 15	*Vater unser im Himmelreich*	Our Father in the kingdom of heaven	Our Father, Thou in Heaven Above	14 of 19
	Warum betrübst du dich, mein Herz	Why art thou troubled, my heart	Why Art Thou Thus Cast Down, My Heart	14 of 19
Trinity 16	*Mitten wir im Leben sind* (In the midst of life we are)	In the midst of life we are	In the Very Midst of Life	15 of 22
Trinity 17	*Wo Gott der Herr nicht bei uns hält*	If God the Lord does not stand by us	If God Had Not Been on Our Side	14 of 20

Sunday or feast	Original title	Literal English	Common English title	Witnesses
	Wär Gott nicht mit uns diese Zeit	Were God not with us at this time	Were God Not with Us at This Time	9 of 20
Trinity 18	*Es ist das Heil uns kommen her*	Salvation has come to us	Salvation unto Us Has Come	13 of 18
	Dies sind die heilgen zehn Gebot	These are the holy ten commandments	These Are the Holy Ten Commands	11 of 18
	Herr Christ, der einig Gotts Sohn	Lord Christ, the only Son of God	The Only Son from Heaven	8 of 18
	Nun freut euch, lieben Christen gmein	Now rejoice, dear Christians together	Dear Christians, One and All, Rejoice	8 of 18
Trinity 19	*Allein zu dir, Herr Jesu Christ*	In thee alone, Lord Jesus Christ	In Thee Alone, O Christ, My Lord	12 of 19
	Aus tiefer Not schrei ich zu dir	Out of deep distress I cry to thee	From Depths of Woe I Cry to Thee	11 of 19
Trinity 20	*Ach Gott, vom Himmel sieh darein*	O God, look down from heaven	O Lord, Look Down from Heaven, Behold	12 of 19
Trinity 21	*Ich ruf zu dir, Herr Jesu Christ*	I call to thee, Lord Jesus Christ	I Call to Thee, Lord Jesus Christ	11 of 18
Trinity 22	*Aus tiefer Not schrei ich zu dir*	Out of deep distress I cry to thee	From Depths of Woe I Cry to Thee	14 of 20
	Erbarm dich mein, o Herre Gott	Have mercy on me, O Lord God	Have Mercy on Me, O Lord God	13 of 20
Trinity 23	*Wo Gott der Herr nicht bei uns hält*	If God the Lord does not stand by us	If God Had Not Been on Our Side	13 of 18
	Wär Gott nicht mit uns diese Zeit	Were God not with us at this time	Were God Not with Us at This Time	10 of 18
Trinity 24	*Mitten wir im Leben sind*	In the midst of life we are	In the Very Midst of Life	9 of 19
	Allein zu dir, Herr Jesu Christ	In thee alone, Lord Jesus Christ	In Thee Alone, O Christ, My Lord	8 of 19
	Herr Jesu Christ, wahr Mensch und Gott	Lord Jesus Christ, true man and God	Lord Jesus Christ, True Man and God	8 of 19
	Mit Fried und Freud ich fahr dahin (With peace and joy I depart)	With peace and joy I depart	In Peace and Joy I Now Depart	6 of 19
Trinity 25–27 (the last Sundays)	*Gott hat das Evangelium*	God has given the gospel	God Gave the Gospel That We May †	9 of 18
	Es wird schier der letzte Tag herkommen (The last day will soon be coming)	The last day will soon be coming	Lo, the Final Day Is Fast Approaching †	7 of 18

Sunday or feast	Original title	Literal English	Common English title	Witnesses
	Ihr lieben Christen, freut euch nun	Ye dear Christians, rejoice now	Rejoice, Rejoice, Ye Christians Dear †	6 of 18
Purification of Mary (2 Feb)	*Mit Fried und Freud ich fahr dahin*	With peace and joy I depart	In Peace and Joy I Now Depart	22 of 23
Annunciation (25 March)	*Mein Seel erhebt den Herren* (My soul magnifies the Lord)	My soul magnifies the Lord	My Soul Now Magnifies the Lord	16 of 17
St John the Baptist (24 June)	*Christ, unser Herr, zum Jordan kam*	Christ our Lord came to the Jordan	To Jordan Came the Christ, Our Lord	9 of 17
	Gelobet sei der Herr, der Gott Israel (Blessed be the Lord, the God of Israel)	Blessed be the Lord, the God of Israel	Blessed Be the Lord, the God of Israel	9 of 17
Visitation of Mary (2 July)	*Mein Seel erhebt den Herren*	My soul magnifies the Lord	My Soul Now Magnifies the Lord	6 of 8
St Michael (29 Sept)	*Nun lob, mein Seel, den Herren*	Now praise the Lord, my soul	My Soul, Now Praise Thy Maker	10 of 16
	Herr Gott, dich loben alle wir (Lord God, we all praise thee)	Lord God, we all praise thee	Lord God, We All to Thee Give Praise	8 of 16

† Title of Matthew Carver's translation, in *Walther's Hymnal* (2012) or on his blog *Hymnoglypt*; the hymn has no received English title.

‡ Assigned by the editor; the old witnesses leave the day open (see §8.A.2). The figure is the number of old witnesses that do give this hymn.

8.A.4 Notes on the table

- **Days not in the table.** The saints' days not listed (St Paul, St Mary Magdalene, St Lawrence, St Martin, All Saints and others) have one old witness or two.
- **The assigned days.** Quasimodogeniti is the one Sunday the old witnesses leave open: Liliencron's concordance records only a single coincidence for it, and no hymn has more than two old witnesses. Only two or three old witnesses give a hymn for Maundy Thursday and the second feast days of Easter and Pentecost. The hymns assigned to these days (‡) are mostly the ones those few witnesses give: Luther's Communion hymn on Maundy Thursday (Carpzov, Selnecker), *Ach bleib bei uns* (Abide with us, Lord Jesus Christ) and *Christ ist erstanden* (Christ is arisen) on Easter Monday (Bach's Leipzig), and *Komm, Heiliger Geist* (Come, Holy Ghost) on Pentecost Monday (Stiller). *O filii et filiae* (O sons and daughters) on Quasimodogeniti has no old witness, but it is the usual choice of the modern lists.
- **Thin days.** On some days the evidence is divided or sparse, and the "of" figure should be read with the count:
  - the Sunday after Christmas;
  - the Sunday after New Year (three witnesses in all);
  - Quinquagesima;
  - Lent 4 and 5;
  - Palm Sunday.
- **One possible double count.** Thompson's column collates Ludecus with twelve other lists and cannot be separated from Ludecus's own entries (Introduction, The hymn database). Where both support a hymn, Ludecus may be counted twice. Thompson is kept, because it is a modern study that collates old sources. Without it, the leading hymn of every day except Lent 4 and Trinity 7, 15 and 24 would stay the same, and on those four days the leading hymns are tied or nearly tied. The hymns at the margin would change on 15 days. For example:
  - Trinity 4 would lose *Mensch, willst du leben seliglich* (Man, wouldst thou live blessedly);

    - Advent 2 would gain *Es wird schier der letzte Tag herkommen* (The last day will soon be coming);
    - Ascension would gain *Nun freut euch, Gottes Kinder, all* (Now rejoice, all ye children of God).
- **What the table shows.**
    - The core of the old *de tempore* (of the season) scheme is very stable. On 36 of the 64 days whose hymn the witnesses choose, one hymn has at least two thirds of the day's witnesses. Examples:
        - Advent 1, *Nun komm* (Now come, Savior of the heathen);
        - Epiphany, *Was fürchtst du, Feind Herodes* (Why dost thou fear so, foe Herod);
        - Easter 5, the Lord's Prayer hymn;
        - Exaudi, *Wo Gott der Herr* (If God the Lord does not stand by us);
        - Pentecost, *Komm, Heiliger Geist*;
        - Trinity Sunday, *Gott der Vater wohn uns bei* (God the Father, dwell with us);
        - Trinity 6 and 13, *Es ist das Heil* (Salvation has come to us);
        - Trinity 8, *Ach Gott, vom Himmel* (O God, look down from heaven);
        - Trinity 10, *An Wasserflüssen Babylon*;
        - the Purification, *Mit Fried und Freud* (With peace and joy I depart);
        - the Annunciation, the German Magnificat.
    - The same hymns return on several Sundays:
        - *Wo Gott der Herr nicht bei uns hält* (If God the Lord does not stand by us) and *Wär Gott nicht mit uns* (Were God not with us at this time) on Epiphany 4, Trinity 17 and Trinity 23;
        - *Vater unser* (Our Father) and *Warum betrübst du dich* (Why art thou troubled, my heart) together on Trinity 7 and 15;
        - *Aus tiefer Not* (Out of deep distress), *Allein zu dir* (In thee alone, Lord Jesus Christ) and *Erbarm dich mein* (Have mercy on me, O Lord God) among Trinity 3, 11, 19 and 22.

Chapter 9. Organ, Instruments and Bells

This chapter covers instrumental music and sounded signals in the church orders of the sixteenth century printed in Emil Sehling's *Die evangelischen Kirchenordnungen des XVI. Jahrhunderts* (The Evangelical Church Orders of the Sixteenth Century). It asks:

- **The organ.** Was it kept? Did the organist play a prelude before the service or before a hymn, interludes between the verses or the parts of the service, or a postlude after the blessing? When was it silent? What might the organist not play?
- **Other instruments.** Were instruments other than the organ played in church? If so, which, when, and by whom?
- **Bells.** Which bells were rung: tower bells, a choir bell, a little bell or handbell at the altar, a Sanctus bell? When were they rung: before church, at the canonical hours, at the consecration and elevation, at the Sanctus, during the Lord's Prayer, at the *Gloria in excelsis* on Easter Day, during certain hymns, for the dead, at baptisms and weddings, against storms?

How the chapter is laid out.

- §9.1 answers each question in brief, and §9.2 sets out the scope and sources.
- §9.3 covers the organ: its defence and its limits, the prelude, the alternation of organ and singers, the postlude, the seasons and rites in which it was silent, and the organist.
- §9.4 covers the other instruments: trombones, town pipers and fiddlers, the carillon and the tower-blower, and the minstrels of weddings.
- §9.5 covers the bells: their purpose, the summons to church, the daily and prayer bells, bells within the Mass, bells at hymns and the litany, the dead, baptisms and weddings, storms, and the lesser signals of sermon and alms.
- §9.6 is a table by order, and §9.7 a concordance of every order quoted.

Related chapters. Several passages are treated more fully elsewhere and are only cited here:

- the organ and polyphony at the introit and other propers: Chapter 4, §§4.4.5, 4.10.4–4.10.5;
- the organ and figural music at the office: Chapter 10, §10.11.4;
- choir, people and organ in the hymns: Chapter 8, §§8.14.7, 8.18.9;
- figural music, the organ and bells as marks of feast rank: Chapter 12, §§12.10.5, 12.10.7;
- bell baptism and weather-ringing, and the organist's contract: Chapter 13, §§13.12.3, 13.15.5;
- the bell-ringer's appointment and pledge: Chapter 13, §13.12.2;
- the length of the sermon that the sermon glass measured: Chapter 11, §11.7.

9.1 Summary of findings

The organ

1. **Kept by the Lutherans, kept out of the service by the Reformed.** Luther would have "all the organs piped" if it served the young (1526). No Lutheran order abolishes the organ. Wittenberg's castle church in 1525 limits it to the Sunday *Te Deum* (We praise thee, O God) and German songs. Strasbourg in 1598 defends "singing and organ-playing" against the Reformed, who cast them out as "papistical leaven". Reformed Emden (1594) keeps its organ but uses it only before the service, while the people gather, and after it, as they leave (§9.3.1).
2. **Preludes: yes, of two kinds** (§9.3.2).
    - **A voluntary while the people gather.** At Strasbourg 1598 the organist begins "at the end of the last ringing"; at Emden 1594 (Reformed), "before nine o'clock, when the people gather".
    - **Announcing each piece.** The organist begins a chant or plays the first stanza of a hymn, and the choir or people take it up (Gelnhausen [1568], Naumburg 1537/38, Nördlingen 1555, Schweinfurt 1576, Hof 1592).
    - Strasbourg requires the prelude to be "even that which the congregation shall afterward sing", not "strange pieces and motets".
    - The practice of the organist "preambulating" before every item belongs to the seventeenth century (Bischofswerda 1676).
3. **Interludes: yes, chiefly as alternation** (§9.3.3).
    - **The usual form.** The organ plays a verse or stanza in turn with choir and people, and the verse it plays is usually not sung (Regensburg 1553, Naumburg, Nördlingen, Prussia 1568, Pomerania 1569, Hof). At Regensburg's Vespers, though, "all the verses [are] nevertheless sung wholly throughout, for the better understanding".

- **Limits on the organ's share.** Strasbourg allows "once or at the most twice" in a hymn; Reutlingen 1574, one stanza after every two sung. At Bergedorf 1544 the people first sing the whole psalm. Schleswig-Holstein 1542 has the German hymns sung "without organ".
- **Pieces between the parts of the service.** These are separate from the alternation (§9.3.4). Schönburg 1542 has them after the epistle, after the Creed, and after the sermon "until the priest come to the altar". Schweinfurt 1576 has one in place of the *Et in terra* (And on earth).

4. **Postludes: yes** (§9.3.5).
   - **After the blessing.** Strasbourg allows "other pieces" or Latin motets for those who wish to stay.
   - **Elsewhere.** Gelnhausen: "Let the organist close with a little piece". Schönburg: "a good piece" after communion. Prussia 1568: a piece after the *Nunc dimittis*. Hamburg 1556: "before and after the sermon". Emden 1594 (Reformed): as the people leave.
5. **Silent seasons and rites** (§9.3.6).
   - **Seasons.** Lent or Passiontide (Hamburg 1529, Nördlingen 1555); Advent II to Christmas Eve (Hof 1592); Rogation week (Pomerania 1569); lower feasts (Henneberg 1582).
   - **Rites.** The litany (Henneberg 1582); communion (Wolfenbüttel 1543, Schönburg 1542 except on high feasts, Reutlingen 1574); baptism (Thorn 1560–1570).
   - **Forbidden music.** Worldly songs, love-songs, dances and galliards (Calenberg-Göttingen 1542, Hamburg 1556, Pomerania 1569, Stettin 1573, Emden 1577 (Reformed)) (§9.3.7).

Other instruments

6. **Rare, and tied to figural music, courts, towns and weddings** (§9.4).
   - **Trombones.** "Trombones and other such instruments" accompany the psalms at the Ansbach court in 1538, and at weddings in church.
   - **Town pipers and fiddlers.** Danzig in 1612 retains the town pipers (three masters, three journeymen) and three fiddlers "for the choir", to play whenever there is figural music.
   - **Emden** (Reformed). The organist-town-piper of 1577 serves with "Christian music and other instruments" on feast days, tends the carillon and blows from the town-hall tower. The editor's notes add trombone-playing "in the organ" (1579), and a tower-watchman's psalms on cornett and trombone (1679).
   - **Wedding minstrels.** Pipes, fiddles, drums and trumpets play the bridal party to the churchyard (Hamburg 1529). They must not disturb the sermon (Nassau-Dillenburg 1570, Herford 1532), and they are withheld from a bride who has lost her honour (Schwäbisch Hall 1543/1615).
   - **Not found.** No order names a lute, regal, cornett or trumpet in the service itself.

Bells

7. **Purpose.** Bells call people to the Word and to prayer, not to "the pomp of the feasts" (Wittenberg 1525, Saxe-Lauenburg 1585). Some orders curbed festal chiming (Danzig 1567, Bentheim 1601 (Reformed)); most kept more bells for greater days (Altenburg 1533, Danzig 1612) (§9.5.1).
8. **Before church.** The usual summons is three signs, the last "together", or three with one bell and a little bell last (Gelnhausen [1568], Esslingen 1540 (Moderate Reformed), Bentheim 1601 (Reformed)). Danzig 1612 names its seven bells and gives the full Sunday and weekday ringing (§9.5.2).
9. **At the canonical hours and through the day** (§9.5.3).
   - **Morning and evening, and the prayer bell.** The ringing at morning and evening was kept, even where no Matins or Vespers was held (Prussia 1544). It was reinterpreted as a bell *pro pace*, for peace, government and against the Turk. Many orders also rang at noon or eleven (Saxony 1528, Allstedt 1533, Meissen 1540, Wolfenbüttel 1543, Kurpfalz 1546, Lüneburg 1564, Hoya 1581, with its prayer). It also served as a time-signal for workers.
   - **The Ave Maria and Salve.** These names were dropped or the ringing recast (Heilbronn 1532, Coburg 1554/55, Lichtenberg 1579).
   - **The Friday bell for the Passion.** Kept by some (Kurpfalz 1546, Thüngen 1564), abolished with the *Tenebrae* ringing by others (Hohenlohe 1582).
10. **At the elevation and consecration** (§9.5.4).
    - **A sign with the little bell before the consecration.** Prussia 1525, Riga 1530 and Kurland 1570.
    - **Ringing at the elevation.** The Danish *Ordinatio* (Ordinance) of 1537 allows it, "the bells meanwhile sounding according to custom". The Interim restored it at Ansbach (1548). At Hof it lasted until about 1560, "with a threefold

pulse of the little bell".

11. **At the Sanctus.** Only Hatzkerode (1534?) rings a bell during the German Sanctus, and that is to call the communicants into the choir. There is no "Sanctus bell" in the corpus (§9.5.4).
12. **During the Lord's Prayer.** Not in the Mass. The Our Father is tied to the bell only in the daily prayer bells and the Friday bell (§9.5.4).
13. **At the *Gloria in excelsis* on Easter.** Not found (§9.5.4).
14. **During hymns and chants** (§9.5.5).
    - **The *Te Deum*.** Ringing to call the people to the sermon and Mass (Prussia 1544 and 1568). All the bells at the Christmas *Te Deum* (Hof 1592).
    - **The litany.** The greatest bell so that those in the field may join in (Hohenlohe 1582), or singing "under the ringing" (Regensburg 1567).
    - **Not found.** No order rings during a particular stanza.
15. **For the dead** (§9.5.6).
    - **Kept as a call to the living.** "That the living also may consider the hour of their own dying" (Meissen 1540).
    - **Abolished.** The Saturday ringing "for all faithful souls" (Zwickau 1529, Reuss 1552).
    - **Regulated.** Equality (Ulm, Moderate Reformed), fees by the number of bells (Danzig 1578), silence during sermons (Herford 1532).
    - **Withheld.** From despisers of the Sacrament (Zwickau 1533) and from unbaptized infants (Lippe 1571).
16. **At baptisms and weddings** (§9.5.7).
    - **Baptism.** A new evangelical custom: a sign with a bell, often the little bell, calls the congregation to a baptism held outside the regular service (Heilbronn c. 1529, Kurpfalz 1556, Ansbach 1556, Limpurg 1610).
    - **Weddings.** At Hof the bell is rung half an hour later than usual.
17. **Against storms.** Kept as a call to prayer by some, abolished by most (§9.5.8; see Chapter 13, §13.15.5).
18. **Small bells.** A little bell in the choir calls the scholars (Prussia 1568); a little bell calls communicants (Haldensleben 1564); a little bell ends the sermon when the hour-glass runs out (Zerbst 1545); and a hand-bell accompanies the alms collection during sermons (Brandis 1529). Little bells at the Sacrament were rejected by the Reformed (Micron) and at Transylvanian sick-communions (§§9.5.4, 9.5.9).

9.2 Scope, sources and method

Sources. The chapter draws on the whole of Sehling's edition as held in `eko.db`: volumes 1–24, including the half-volumes, with the editors' introductions and notes. Passages from an editor's introduction or note are marked as such, and so are witnesses later than about 1615, which are cited only for comparison: Bischofswerda 1676, and the Emden tower-watchman of 1679 (Reformed).

Searches. The corpus was searched for:

- **The organ and organist**: *orgel* (organ), *orgeln*, *organist*, *organicen*, *organum* (organ), *präambulieren* (prelude), *schlagen* (strike [the organ]) near a chant or hymn.
- **Other instruments**: *posaune* (trombone)/*basune* (trombone), *zinke* (cornett), *pfeifer* (piper), *fidler* (fiddler)/*geige* (fiddle), *laute* (lute), *trommete* (trumpet)/*trompete* (trumpet), *pauke* (kettledrum), *bunge* (drum), *saitenspiel* (stringed instruments), *spielleute* (minstrels), *instrument*, *klockenspil* (chime of bells), *cymbala* (cymbals).
- **Bells**: *glocke* (bell), *glöcklein* (little bell), *schelle* (small bell), *campana* (bell)/*campanula* (little bell), *leuten* (ring)/*läuten* (ring)/*lüden* (ring), *beiern* (chime), *puls* (pulse of the bell), *zeichen* (sign), *pro pace* (for peace), *betglocke* (prayer bell), *Ave Maria*, *Salve*, *wetterleuten* (ringing against storms), *tenebre* (Tenebrae), *schiedung* (passing bell).

Because *leuten* ("ring") is spelled like *Leute* ("people") in many of the orders, ringing passages were found by searching for a bell word within a few words of a ringing verb, and of the Mass item in question (Sanctus, elevation, consecration, *Pater noster*, *Gloria*, *Te Deum* [We praise thee, O God], litany, baptism, burial, wedding, storm).

Negative findings. Several things the chapter reports as "not found" were searched for directly:

- a "Sanctus bell" (*Sanctusglocke* or any compound), a *Wandlungsglocke*, a hand-bell (*Handglocke*);
- ringing during the Lord's Prayer of the Mass;
- ringing at the Easter *Gloria in excelsis*;

- ringing at a named stanza of a hymn;
- a regal, a lute, a cornett or a trumpet in the service.

A passage phrased in an unexpected way may have escaped these searches. The negatives mean only that no such passage was found.

What the chapter does not repeat. The chapter does not repeat what is quoted in full elsewhere; see the related chapters listed at the head of this chapter.

9.3 The organ

9.3.1 Kept, and defended

Luther. Luther's preface to the *Deutsche Messe* (German Mass) names the organ in the same breath as the bells, as means that may serve the teaching of the young. **Luther, *Deutsche Messe und ordnung gottis diensts*, 1526** (Sehling 1, p. 11):

for the sake of such must one read, sing, preach, write and make verses; and where it were helpful and furthering thereto, I would have all the bells rung thereto, and all the organs piped, and let sound everything that could sound.

Wittenberg 1525. The Wittenberg order for the castle church, a year earlier, is far more sparing. The bells are a signal, not festal pomp, and the organ, since it is already there, may sound only at the Sunday *Te Deum* (We praise thee, O God) and at German songs. **Wittenberg, *Wie es einer zeit mit den ceremonien der kirchen gehalten wirt*, 1525** (Sehling 1, p. 699):

Item, let them use the bells for a sign, whereby it may be signified when they are to come together to the singing and when to the hearing of the word of God. But let them not use them for that pomp of the feasts. The organs (since they are already there) they may use, if they will, only on the Lord's day at the *Te Deum laudamus* (We praise thee, O God), and whenever they sing German songs.

The Lutheran norm. No Lutheran order in the corpus abolishes the organ. Where a church had one, the orders assume an organist and regulate him. Wolfenbüttel 1543 commends him as "honest, and good also for the service of the art of music", and lets the pastor, council and treasury pay him "more or less, according to the worth of his art, for organists are very unequal" (Sehling 6/1, p. 45).

Strasbourg 1598 against the Reformed. By the end of the century the organ had to be defended. The Strasbourg order of 1598 opens its chapter "Of singing and the organs" against those who would cast singing and organ out of the church as popish leaven. Sehling's editor notes that the Reformed are meant. **Strasbourg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1598** (Sehling 20/1, pp. 602–603):

Even as we cannot nor ought to approve the manifold abuse which was practised in the papacy with singing and organs, so likewise can we not praise nor approve the purpose of those who cast singing and organ-playing wholly out of the church as mere papistical leaven. […] But as touching figural music and the organs, experience itself showeth that thereby the hearts and minds of the hearers are stirred up and refreshed to laud and praise God the Lord the more joyfully with their mouth and singing also. Yet shall it be in every way looked to, that such figural music and organ-playing neither hinder nor too long hold up the common singing of the whole church, nor the rest of the service with preaching and praying.

The Reformed. The Reformed orders went the other way. Micron's London order (Reformed) (German edition 1565) rejects "altars, lights, little bells, vestments" (§9.5.4). At Reformed Emden the organ survived in the great church, but it was kept out of the service altogether. **Emden, *Kirchenordnung*, 1594** (Reformed; Sehling 7/1, p. 489):

Of the organ there is no use during the singing, nor at the service, save only on Sunday before nine o'clock, when the people gather, and afterward, when it goeth out of the church again.

The editor adds that the Reformed synods of Dordrecht (1574, 1578) and Middelburg (1581) pressed for the abolition of organ-playing, and that in some Dutch towns the organ passed to the town council, which had the organist play at set hours to keep people out of the taverns (Sehling 7/1, p. 476, editor's note). The Emden order thus gives exactly the two places that Lutheran orders also gave the organ outside the singing: a prelude while the people gather and a postlude as they leave.

9.3.2 The prelude

The orders know two kinds of prelude: a voluntary while the congregation gathers, and the organist's announcement of each piece before it is sung.

While the people gather. Strasbourg has the organist begin as soon as the last bell has stopped and "a fair congregation" is there, and play nothing but what the people are about to sing. **Strasbourg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1598** (Sehling 20/1, p. 603):

Therefore, when one will use figural music and the organ, it shall be held after the following manner. First, that the organist begin betimes, at the end of the last ringing, as soon as a fair congregation is assembled; as likewise the singers shall do at all other sermons, even when there is no organ-playing or figural music. Secondly, that before and during the singing of the church he play no strange pieces and motets, but even that which the congregation shall afterward sing.

The Emden order of 1594 (Reformed; §9.3.1) has the same voluntary "before nine o'clock, when the people gather".

The organ begins each piece. In the orders that describe the festal service in detail, the organ begins the hymn or chant and the singers take it up. At Gelnhausen the organist begins the *Veni Sancte Spiritus* (Come, Holy Spirit), plays the first stanza of the German psalm, and plays "a little piece" after it. The editor glosses "strike the first stanza" as "plays the first stanza". **Gelnhausen, *Kirchenordnung*, [1568]** (Sehling 9, p. 652):

After the first sign hath been rung at seven o'clock, both summer and winter, the second at half past seven, and [all the bells] together at eight, let the organist (if there be one) begin the *Veni Sancte Spiritus*; afterward let the choir sing it out. Thereupon let the organist begin a German psalm, play the first stanza, [and] afterward let the choir sing it out, without alternation of the organ. After the psalm let the organist play a little piece; thereupon followeth the collect and lesson; after that let the organist begin sometimes *Nun bitten wir* (Now pray we), sometimes *Wir glauben all an einen Gott* (We all believe in one God), [and] let the choir sing it quite out. […] Thereupon followeth the collect and benediction. Let the organist close with a little piece.

Schweinfurt 1576 likewise has "the organist begin to play the Sunday Kyrie, which the choir singeth after", and at the Sunday introit the organist "beginneth to play the introit, which the choir singeth after, as is customary" (Sehling 11, pp. 647–648). At Hof the organist "always first plays the melody" of each verse of the German *Magnificat* (Sehling 11, p. 429; see Chapter 10, §10.11.4).

"The organist playeth a prelude". The fullest late example is not a sixteenth-century order. It is a service order sent by the council of Bischofswerda to its cantor in 1676, printed by Sehling in a note. The organist "preambulates" before the Kyrie, after the epistle, after the Gospel and catechism, and before the blessing; at the noon service before the hymn, before the sermon hymn and before the hour of prayer (Sehling 2, p. 106). It shows where the practice of the sixteenth-century orders led, but it is late evidence and is cited here only for comparison.

9.3.3 Interludes and alternation

Alternation. The commonest use of the organ in the orders is *alternatim*: the organ takes a verse or stanza in turn with the choir or people, and the verse it takes is played, not sung. Regensburg is explicit. Sehling's editor glosses the first sentence "that is, these pieces are not sung", and the communion stanzas "as an interlude". **Regensburg, *Kirchenordnung* of Justus Jonas, 1553** (Sehling 13, p. 421):

But if an organist be present, he playeth the introit together with the *Kyrie eleison*, *Et in terra* (And on earth), *Patrem* (the Nicene Creed), Sanctus and *Agnus Dei* (Lamb of God) on the organ, and also under the communion, in the German songs, one stanza after another. […] And where the organist is present, he playeth [at Sunday Vespers] one verse after the other on the organ; yet so that all the verses be nevertheless sung wholly throughout, for the better understanding.

Three and four choirs. Naumburg's St Wenzel order sets out the German songs in alternation of schoolboys and people, each with its own cantor. When the organ plays there are three choirs, and when the maidens sing, four. **Naumburg, *Kirchen-Ordnung* for St Wenzel, 1537/1538** (Sehling 2, p. 72):

And all such songs as are German are sung, when the people is assembled, one choir after the other: the scholars' choir singeth and beginneth a stanza, and after that the people keepeth the other choir, which also hath its own cantor. But when the organ is played, three choirs are kept, and the organ always beginneth, save that at the *Et in terra* the boys begin and after them the organ, thereupon the choir and then the people. But when the maidens also sing in choir, four choirs are kept, and the three choirs sing all the stanzas of the German songs, one verse after the other, and the organist playeth in between in the [same] tone.

The same passage, almost word for word, stands in Caspar Löner's Nördlingen order as revised in 1555 (Sehling 12, p. 320). Hof's three-choir introit with organ, boys, older boys and girls is quoted in Chapter 4, §4.4.5.

How much the organ might take. The orders that care most for the congregation's singing limit the organ's share:

- **Strasbourg 1598**: after intoning, the organist may play "not more than once or at the most twice" amid the church's singing (quoted in §9.3.5).
- **Reutlingen 1574**: two stanzas sung, then one played, "about as long as one of the sung stanzas", so that the young and the people learn the hymns. **Reutlingen, *Artikel der Schulvisitation*, 1574** (Sehling 17/2, p. 58):

but on other Sundays and holy days always two verses or two stanzas shall be sung, and thereupon one (which might last about as long as one of the sung stanzas) shall be played on the organ; to the end that the Christian church songs may be the better known to the youth and the common people, and they the more stirred up to sing along with one accord and diligently.

- **Bergedorf 1544**: the organ may play on feast days, but only after the people have sung the whole psalm, and only what has been sung. **Bergedorf, *Kirchenordnung*, 1544** (Sehling 5, p. 389):

Where also there be organs in the churches, one may well use them on the holy days, [and] play the psalms and the aforesaid church song thereon; yet so that the people sing the whole psalms first, and that on the organs only that be played which hath been sung.

- **Schleswig-Holstein 1542**: in the cathedral and collegiate churches the Latin Gloria alternates choir and organ, but the German Gloria, the German hymn in place of the sequence and the German Creed are sung by "the whole church" straight through "without organ". **Schleswig-Holstein, *Kirchenordnung*, 1542** (Sehling 23, p. 146):

But on Sunday or on the feasts, when the priest hath sung *Gloria in excelsis Deo* (Glory to God in the highest), and the choir and not the organ hath answered *Et in terra pax hominibus bonae voluntatis* (And on earth peace to men of good will), then shall they stop altogether, that the whole church may afterward sing *Allein Gott in der Höh sei Ehr* (To God alone on high be glory), etc., which song shall be sung without break to the end, without organ-playing. After that the choir and organ go on to sing *Laudamus te* (We praise thee), *Benedicimus te* (We bless thee), etc., to the end; after that the Alleluia. But in the stead of the sequence the whole church shall again sing a German song without break and also without organ.

Organ and the people's hymn at communion. Pomerania's *Agenda* lets the organ play during the communion hymns, but only three times: once at the beginning, once in the middle and once at the end. **Pomerania, *Agenda*, 1569** (Sehling 4, p. 439):

When these songs are sung under the communion, the organists shall make their song on the organ the shorter, and play no worldly, light songs. The pastor shall provide that the organs be so moderated that the German psalms under the communion be sung with the congregation wholly to the end, and that the aforesaid songs be sung in turn, the choir and the people singing one verse after the other, so that they all be alike in use by the scholars and the congregation. Therefore the organist may play once at the beginning, once in the middle as occasion serveth, [and] once at the end, before the collect.

Hamburg 1556 lets the organist play "fittingly in between" the verses of the German psalm sung in place of the alleluia and sequence, "as elsewhere is customary, or, as the time allows, close the song with the organ" (Sehling 5, p. 552). Stettin forbids its organists to "fantasize on the organ while other good Christians sing the psalms with the congregation" (§9.3.7).

9.3.4 Organ pieces between the parts of the service

Beside the alternation, some orders give the organ a short piece of its own between the parts of the service. The fullest list is Schönburg's. **Schönburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1542** (Sehling 2, pp. 170–171):

Before the introit, [at the] *Kyrie eleison*, the choir shall sing one Kyrie, one Christe and again one Kyrie, and the organist play thereto. At or before the last he may also play a good short little piece, etc. […] 3. After the epistle the organist playeth; thereupon the choir singeth the alleluia, sometimes the sequence, so far as it is pure and Christian; thereupon the whole church [singeth] a German psalm or Christian song, whichever one will, as is found in the song-book. 4. After the Gospel [and] the *Patrem* (the Nicene Creed), etc., in Latin, the organist playeth; the church singeth *Wir glauben* (We believe), etc. 5. After the sermon the organist playeth something, until the priest come to the altar and have prepared the bread and the cup to be offered. […] 7. […] The organist shall not play under the communion, except on high feasts; but after the communion is held he may play a good piece.

Schweinfurt 1576 puts an organ piece in the place of the *Et in terra* (And on earth): "upon the Gloria, etc., and instead of the *Et in terra*, etc., the organist playeth some music" (Sehling 11, p. 647). Gelnhausen's "little piece" after the psalm (§9.3.2) is of the same kind.

9.3.5 The postlude

After the blessing. Strasbourg keeps the organist's freer music, and Latin motets, for the end of the service, when those who want to listen may stay and the rest may go about their business. **Strasbourg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1598** (Sehling 20/1, p. 603):

And that the organ-playing and singing be not drawn out too long, he shall, after he hath intoned, play not more than once, or at the most twice, amid the singing of the church, but leave it its time to perform its singing with common voice and devotion. But when the service is wholly performed and the blessing given to the people, then may the organist play other pieces also, or have Latin motets sung; whereat those will without doubt always gladly stay who have pleasure and liking thereto; and yet the common people, which would rather go after its business, is not thereby hindered nor held up. When also the songs which the people singeth are divided, so that either the organist playeth between, or a part of the song is kept until after the sermon (which latter yet shall be done only with the longer songs), one shall so divide the songs that what belongeth together in sense and content remain together and be not torn from one another.

Other postludes.

- **Gelnhausen [1568]**: "Let the organist close with a little piece" (§9.3.2).
- **Schönburg 1542**: "after the communion is held he may play a good piece" (§9.3.4).
- **Emden 1594** (Reformed): the organ only "when it goeth out of the church again" (§9.3.1).
- **Prussia 1568**: at Vespers the organist plays alternate verses of the *Magnificat*, and "after the *Nunc dimittis*" plays a piece. **Prussia, *Kirchenordnung und Ceremonien*, 1568** (Sehling 4, p. 75):

Where there is an organist, he playeth one verse after the other, so that after the *Magnificat* the choir singeth the German antiphon, and the organist after the *Nunc dimittis* playeth a piece. Thereupon they close with the versicle, collects and *Benedicamus Domino* (Let us bless the Lord).

- **Hamburg 1556**: the organists are to play "before and after the sermon" on holy days and working days, and at Vespers on all holy eves and days. **Hamburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1556** (Sehling 5, p. 547):

That organists well skilled in their art and honest men be taken on. These shall play on the organs, both on holy days and working days, in the churches where there is preaching at eight o'clock, before and after the sermon, also at Vespers on all holy eves and days, according to the direction of the choir's *ordinarius*. The organists shall agree with those in the choir about the singing, and play on the organs in accord with what they begin in the choir. The organists shall refrain from playing worldly, scurrilous and unseemly songs in the churches.

9.3.6 When the organ was silent

Seasons.

- **Lent and Passiontide.** Hamburg 1529 lets the organ "rest for a time, especially the fortnight over, when the Passion is preached" (Sehling 5, p. 513). Nördlingen 1555 lets the organ "remain out" in Lent until Easter, except on the Annunciation (Sehling 12, p. 320).
- **Advent.** Hof suspends the organ from the second Sunday of Advent to Christmas Eve. **Hof, *Ordo ecclesiasticus*, 1592** (Sehling 11, p. 432):

Note. On this Sunday the organs are suspended until the vigil of the Nativity of Christ.

- **Rogation week.** Pomerania 1569 has "no figural song nor organ" in Rogation week, except on the Ascension and its vigil (Sehling 4, p. 466; quoted in Chapter 12, §12.10.5).
- **Lower feasts.** Henneberg 1582 keeps the lower feasts "without organ", and Aschersleben 1575 sings the Vespers of apostles' days "without the organist" (cited in Chapter 12, §12.10.5).

Rites.

- **The litany.** On the Henneberg prayer day of 1582 the German litany is sung "without organ or figural music" (Sehling 2, p. 311).
- **The communion.** Wolfenbüttel forbids the organ after the sermon in the Mass, so that the Supper may be attended to "in remembrance of Christ". **Wolfenbüttel, *Kirchenordnung*, 1543** (Sehling 6/1, p. 45):

Otherwise the organist may play every Sunday at the pastor's will. But in the Mass one shall not make it long, that the sermon be not hindered, and that the laity also have room there to praise Christ with German song. Yet after the sermon in the Mass one shall not play on the organs, but attend only to the Supper of Christ there, in remembrance of Christ.

Schönburg 1542 likewise keeps the organ silent under the communion except on high feasts (§9.3.4), and Reutlingen 1574 drops the organ "wholly" on communion days because the service is then longer (Sehling 17/2, p. 58).

- **Baptism.** At Thorn baptism is to be held when the church is quiet, not under the singing or the organ. **Thorn, *Kirchenordnung*, 1560–1570** (Sehling 4, p. 230):

Baptism shall be held when it is still in the church, not under the singing or organ-playing, with all devotion and reverence, and not with the idle chatter of the bystanders

At weddings, by private arrangement. Hamburg 1529 allows the organ and the scholars' *Te Deum* (We praise thee, O God), or figural music, at a wedding, "as the people have arranged it with the organist and cantor for their drink-money" (§9.4.4).

9.3.7 The organist: what he might not play

The orders do not prescribe repertory beyond the hymns and chants. They forbid the secular:

- **Calenberg-Göttingen 1542**: organists are to set the spiritual songs themselves or obtain settings, "for love-songs and worldly songs are not at all fitting to be played in the congregation". **Calenberg-Göttingen, *Kirchenordnung*, 1542** (Sehling 6/2, p. 785):

Likewise the organists also shall take diligence that they either set the spiritual songs themselves or obtain them set by others. For love-songs and worldly songs are not at all fitting to be played in the congregation, for this cause, that after the teaching of Paul, 1 Corinthians 14, all things there should be done unto edifying.

- **Hamburg 1556**: no "worldly, scurrilous and unseemly songs" (§9.3.5).
- **Pomerania 1569**: "no worldly, light songs" (§9.3.3).
- **Stettin 1573**: the visitation's articles for the organists. **Stettin, *Visitations-Abschied*, 1573** (Sehling 4, p. 533):

III. Since also mischief and harm follow when strangers come upon the organ without distinction, they shall let no one upon it without the pastor's knowledge […]. V. [They shall] tune and set the same at the right time, not when confession is being heard or the singing hath already begun. VI. They shall also play no worldly songs or dances on the organ. […] IX. They shall also be of one mind with the cantors, not often, to their vexation, pitch too high, or otherwise howl underneath, or fantasize on the organs when other good Christians are singing the psalms with the congregation. X. [They shall] not overcharge the people at weddings, when they are required to attend in the churches, but take what is appointed. XI. They shall not pass themselves off as common minstrels, from which contempt of the ministry followeth. XII. That they also hold the ministry in all honour, and do not run straight from the organ out of the church and despise and neglect God's word.

- **Emden 1577** (Reformed): the town's organist, who was also the town piper, is forbidden "all galliards and other light dances" (§9.4.2).

Cantor, organist and pastor. The organist is subject to the pastor (Hamburg 1556, Stettin 1573) and is to agree with the choir about what is sung (Hamburg 1556). His appointment by contract is treated in Chapter 13, §13.12.3 (Hildesheim 1581).

9.4 Other instruments

In brief. Apart from the organ, the church orders mention instruments in church only rarely, and then for figural music on feasts, at a court, or at weddings. The instruments named are trombones (*Posaunen*, *basunen*), the town pipers' wind instruments (*Pfeifer*), fiddles (*Fidler*), and, outside the service, the carillon, the cornett and trombone of the tower-blower, and the drums,

trumpets, pipes and strings of the wedding minstrels. No order in the corpus names a regal, a lute, a cornett or a trumpet in the service itself, and none names a "Sanctus trumpet" or any instrumental signal at the altar other than a bell.

9.4.1 Trombones at the Ansbach court, 1538

Margrave George's mandate of 1538 in defence of figural and choral singing tells the clergy that at his residence at Ansbach the psalms and other scriptural songs are not only sung but accompanied with trombones and other instruments, as is also done at weddings in church. **Ansbach, *Figural und coral zu ziemlicher zeit in der kirchen zu singen*, 1538** (Sehling 11, p. 397):

So also do we cause such songs, namely psalms and other things drawn out of the holy divine Scripture, and not worldly ditties that provoke to lewdness, here at Onolzbach, as at our princely residence (at fitting time), not only to be sung, but also have these songs assisted with trombones and other such instruments (not for the pleasure of us or ours, but first of all, yea, solely to the honour of God Almighty, whereto this, like all else, shall in the end be directed and meant), as is also not unseemly done and observed here at all weddings in the church.

9.4.2 Emden (Reformed): the organist as town piper, the carillon and the tower

In 1577 the council of Emden engaged Paul Hanssen, already the town piper, as organist of the great church for a year. His contract binds him to the organ, to "Christian music and other instruments" on feast days, to the carillon, and to blowing from the town-hall tower with a journeyman and a pupil. **Emden, *Organistenvertrag*, 1577** (Reformed; Sehling 7/1, pp. 475–478):

3. Thirdly, he shall serve the organ with diligence and good care, and on the feast days serve with Christian music and other instruments according therewith, so far as he may. […] 4. Item, [he shall] tend the carillon at the customary times, as hath been done hitherto. […] 6. And whereas he will now this year serve both offices together, he shall at his own cost keep a good journeyman beside him for the town's service, who with him and one of his pupils fit thereto [shall] twice every week [blow] from the town-hall tower […] 8. Item, he shall in no wise play any galliards or other light dances, much less keep dancing-schools.

The sixth article goes on to have the tower-blowing done also "through the whole eight days" of the annual fairs. Sehling's editor adds from the church accounts that in 1579 Paul's brother Janken was paid "for that he adorned the church with trombone-blowing in the organ", that boys sang at the high feasts "in the organ" in 1584 and 1587, and that a tower-watchman engaged in 1679 had to blow "a psalm with cornett and trombone" at eleven and at sunset, and a verse of a psalm or hymn every hour of the night (Sehling 7/1, pp. 476–477, editor's notes). The last is a seventeenth-century witness, and the instruments in the organ were added to a Reformed service whose order of 1594 kept the organ out of the singing (§9.3.1).

9.4.3 Danzig: town pipers and fiddlers in the choir, 1612

The Danzig order of 1612 is the one order in the corpus that puts instrumentalists on the church's payroll for the service. Beside the choir-men and assistants, the town pipers (three masters and three journeymen) and three fiddlers are retained "for the choir", and must come "with their instruments" whenever there is figural music, and obey the *Kapellmeister*. **Danzig, *Kirchenordnung für Danzig*, 1612** (Sehling 4, p. 212):

Further, beside these choir-men and assistants, the town pipers, namely three masters and three journeymen, are kept for the choir […]. Item, beside these pipers there are also engaged for the choir three fiddlers; to them together is given every quarter 9 marks, which maketh for the whole year 36 marks. Both these kinds of minstrels have also this benefit, that they are preferred before others at weddings, and no strange minstrels may encroach upon them. […] For this salary and these perquisites both the pipers and the fiddlers are bound, whenever there is to be figural music, to present themselves betimes with their instruments beside the choir-men and assistants, and with them to obey the *Kapellmeister* in all things, as is ordained for the music; and whoever is found negligent herein shall be punished at the discretion of the churchwardens. Likewise they are bound to attend at the time of nuptial Masses, since they receive their pay for it from the bridegroom.

The lutenists named in Danzig's ordinances on wedding feasts belong to the feast, not to the church (Sehling 4, p. 197).

9.4.4 Weddings: minstrels to the churchyard gate

The minstrels of a wedding procession played the bridal party to church. The orders let them play up to the churchyard and keep them out of the service.

Hamburg 1529. The minstrels play before the bride and bridegroom as far as the churchyard; in church there may be organ and singing by private arrangement. **Hamburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1529** (Sehling 5, p. 516):

so that in the forenoon the bridegroom with the men go before, and after them the bride with her company, to the church, and the minstrels play before them as far as the churchyard. There one may then in the church play on the organs and sing with the scholars *Te Deum laudamus*, or something else of God, or also in figural music, etc., as the people have then arranged it with the organist and cantor for their drink-money. There they are then wedded before the high altar, as is customary

Not during the sermon. Nassau-Dillenburg bids the wedding party come to church in time, so that the preacher is not disturbed by their music. **Nassau-Dillenburg, *Visitationsabschied*, 1570** (Sehling 10, p. 112):

The bridegroom and bride also, together with their kinsfolk and invited guests, shall be found at church in good time at the appointed hour of preaching, that the preacher, if he had already begun the sermon, be not put out, nor others made unquiet, by the piping, fiddling and other wedding music

Herford 1532 asks the council to keep everything silent near the church while the sermon is preached: bells, drums, trumpets and pipes. **Herford, *Kirchenordnung*, 1532** (Sehling 21, p. 171):

It is also needful and seemly that they refrain and be still during the preaching: all bells, be it for the dead or not; item drums and trumpets, pipes and such things as might disturb the preachers or hearers on the churchyard, or otherwise near by the church

A sign of honour withheld. At Schwäbisch Hall a couple who had not waited for their wedding went to church without music. **Schwäbisch Hall, *Kirchenordnung*, 1543/1615** (Sehling 17/1, p. 155):

Bride and bridegroom who have not waited for their honour, but have acted against it, and this hath been found out, shall go to church without string-music, and the bride with covered head.

Trumpets and kettledrums at the feast. The trumpets and drums named in the orders belong to the wedding procession and feast, and the sumptuary orders regulate or forbid them:

- **Bremen 1546**: all estates may use the council's minstrels, "the first two with the trumpets and the other two with pipes and drums" (Sehling 7/2.2, p. 496).
- **Danzig 1590/1595**: the wedding ordinances forbid trumpets, the military fanfare (*Feldgeschrei*) and kettledrums at weddings, as "no burgher's merriment" (Sehling 4, p. 195).
- **Nordstrand 1605**: trumpets are wholly forbidden at weddings, christening feasts and other feasts (Sehling 23, p. 411).
- **Ulm 1531** (Moderate Reformed): according to the editor, the council's decree of 18 June 1531 on baptisms and weddings asked that weddings be blessed without any display, including music with drums, wind and string instruments (Sehling 17/2, p. 68, editor's introduction).

The organist as minstrel. Stettin 1573 forbids its organists to overcharge for playing at weddings, or to "pass themselves off as common minstrels" (§9.3.7). Ansbach 1538 (§9.4.1) and Danzig 1612 (§9.4.3) show instruments at weddings in church; Hof 1592 has figural music "before and after" the wedding (Sehling 11, p. 430).

9.4.5 Drums on the tower at Zwickau

The visitors at Zwickau stopped the drumming and carousing on the tower of St Mary's, like the fencing-school, during the Sunday afternoon sermon. **Zwickau, *Verordnung der Visitatoren*, 1533** (Sehling 1, p. 723):

The drumming and carousing on the church tower of Our Dear Lady, likewise the fencing-school, shall cease during the afternoon sermon of the Sunday and other feasts, and not be held until after the end of the same sermon.

9.5 Bells

9.5.1 What the bells are for

A signal to the Word and to prayer. The orders agree that bells exist to call people to the preaching of the Word and to common prayer. Wittenberg 1525 (§9.3.1) allows them "for a sign … when they are to come together to the singing and when to

the hearing of the word of God", and not "for that pomp of the feasts". Saxe-Lauenburg sets out the same principle, then forbids weather-ringing and secular use of the bells. **Saxe-Lauenburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1585** (Sehling 5, p. 423):

And since the bells were ordained chiefly for the sake of divine service, that the people be summoned by them to the hearing of God's word and to common prayer, and yet in the papacy horrible abuse and superstition have been practised with the bells, as to drive asunder the terrible thunderstorms with them, such godless doing shall hereby be wholly abolished, and forbidden on pain of penalty and heavy displeasure. And the bells shall not be touched nor pulled for any worldly use or matter, unless it be that the people must be rung together because of the enemy or of fire, or when the labour-services are to be announced to the people, or otherwise in necessary common affairs. And all such ringing shall be done by none but the sexton, since the bells are committed to him by virtue of his office.

Against pomp. Some orders cut back the festal ringing and chiming as a relic of the old feasts:

- **Danzig 1567**: "the ringing and chiming on the feasts and their vigils, which are not appointed and have no ground in God's word", is to be left off by the ringers, "to avoid papistical suspicion" (Sehling 4, p. 187).
- **Bentheim 1601** (Reformed): the count renews his mandate against "the unnecessary, manifold ringing, and especially the superstitious chiming with the bells", on Sundays and feasts as at funerals. **Bentheim-Tecklenburg, *Mandat zum Glockenläuten*, 1601** (Reformed; Sehling 22, p. 302):

that they [the sextons] shall henceforth wholly refrain from chiming with the bells, and on Sundays and also on feast days ring to the sermons three times beforehand, one after the other, with one bell only, and, when that is done, at the end, last of all, with a little bell, if there be one; and at the burial of the dead keep to the measure expressly set out in his Grace's church order; and shall in no wise henceforth make use of the other excessive daily ringing

Rank by bells. Most Lutheran orders, though, kept the festal ringing as a mark of the day. At the Altenburg castle chapter in 1533, working days are rung in with one great bell, and Sundays and feasts "with more bells, to distinguish the time" (Sehling 1, p. 516; quoted in Chapter 12, §12.10.7). Danzig 1612 chimes the great feasts with the three larger bells and the small feasts "with the Osanna" (ibid.).

9.5.2 The summons to church

Three signs. The usual summons is three spells of ringing, often with different bells, the last of them "together" (*zusammen*) with all the bells:

- **Gelnhausen [1568]**: the first sign at seven, the second at half past seven, and all together at eight (§9.3.2).
- **Bentheim 1601** (Reformed): three times with one bell, then a little bell last (§9.5.1).
- **Esslingen 1540** (Moderate Reformed): a forewarning with the bell used on working days for singing, then a second, short sign with the noon bell, after which the sermon begins at once. **Esslingen, *Läuteordnung für den Predigtgottesdienst*, 1540** (Moderate Reformed; Sehling 17/2, p. 394):

that henceforth on Sundays, to the three sermons before and after noon, one shall always ring a fore-sign with the singing bell, which is wont to be used on working days, a good while; and afterward, when the sermons are about to begin, the second sign with the noon bell, and that quite short. So that when the same second sign with the said noon bell hath been rung out, the sermons be begun straightway.

Restored where it had been dropped. At Allstedt the visitors of 1533 restored the ringing to the sermon "where Thomas Müntzer abolished it" (Sehling 1, p. 511; quoted in §9.5.3).

Kept plain. Heilbronn's sexton was told around 1529 to ring only "for the early-Mass sermon and child baptism, but never more for the office of the Mass and Vespers" (Sehling 17/1, p. 226, editor's introduction; §9.5.7). Zwickau 1529 keeps the ringing to sermon, Mass and Vespers, but "to Vespers and for the dead, also early to the lesson", with one bell only (§9.5.6).

The sexton and the clock. Ringing was the sexton's office. Hamburg 1529 bids the sextons "take care that all the bells strike evenly and rightly" (Sehling 5, p. 512). Saxe-Lauenburg 1585 asks the pastors to get village churches a striking clock, or at least a sundial, "or that the sexton at least have a compass, whereby he may know how to order himself with the ringing and other things at the due time" (Sehling 5, p. 423).

The Danzig bells, 1612. The fullest description of a ring of bells and its use is the Danzig order of 1612 for St Mary's. **Danzig, *Kirchenordnung für Danzig*, 1612** (Sehling 4, pp. 202–203):

Art. 12. How many bells there are on the church tower, and what they are called; item, how they are used. The first and greatest bell is called of old Ave Maria, because it is the prayer bell. It is also called Sigismund, and nowadays commonly the great bell; it is pulled by twelve men. The second is called Osanna, also the storm bell, and is pulled by five men. The third is called Apostolica, because it is chimed on the apostles' days, as followeth hereafter, and is pulled by five men. The fourth is called Dominicalis, because it is used every Sunday; [it is] pulled by four men. The fifth is called Ferialis, because it is used every day; [it is] pulled by two men. The sixth is called Sybilla or *Campana Cymbala*, because one signals with it at all times when it is needful, and it is sounded by one man. The seventh hangeth above all these bells and is called the long bell, because at a set time it is rung either a whole hour or at the shortest a half hour long. It is also called the land bell, because one can hear it far out in the country round about the city; the same is pulled by one man. […] On Sunday in the morning, when the clock striketh four, a pulse of three-score pulls or a little longer is rung with the Dominical, and soon after the long bell, until it strike five; soon after, when it hath struck five, with the Dominical and Ferial together, of two score-and-sixty pulls [twice three-score]; after that, when it hath struck six, a pulse of twice three-score pulls is rung with the Osanna to the morning sermon; and then at half past eleven by the clock, at midday, with the Osanna to the midday sermon.

The article goes on to the afternoon, the working days, funerals (signalled with the Sybilla, then rung with the bells the family has paid for), the apostles' days, and the high and low feasts.

9.5.3 The daily bells: morning, noon and evening, and the prayer for peace

Kept for prayer. The morning and evening bell of the medieval *Angelus* (the "Ave Maria") and the evening *Salve* bell were nearly everywhere kept, but given a new meaning: a call to pray for peace (*pro pace*), for the government and against the Turk, and a time-signal for workers. The Prussian order of 1544 keeps the daily ringing in villages even where there is no Matins or Vespers. **Prussia, *Kirchenordnung*, 1544** (Sehling 4, p. 67):

It is not an evil custom that in villages and small market towns one ringeth daily, after old custom, at morning and evening, although one holdeth there neither Matins nor Vespers, but for a reminder to the people, whereby an outward token is given to prayer, be it in the houses or in the field, to pray for the common peace and all manner of welfare, and for thanksgiving for all the benefits of the Lord God. Therefore it is thought good that it be kept daily so henceforth.

Saxony 1528. The Saxon visitors tell pastors not to quarrel with their people over the *pacem* ringing, but to teach them its right use. **Saxony (Ernestine), *Unterricht der Visitatoren*, 1528** (Sehling 1, p. 170):

Many pastors also quarrel with their parishioners about needless and childish matters, as about the ringing of the *pacem* and the like. In such matters the pastors, as the reasonable ones, should rightly give way to the people for peace's sake, and instruct them, where such ringing is wrongly used, that it be well used from now on

Allstedt 1533. The *pro pace* ringing stays, but "the abuse with the Ave Maria" is gone, and the people are to pray for peace and give thanks. **Allstedt, *Ordnung der Visitatoren für die Stadt und das Amt Allstedt*, 1533** (Sehling 1, p. 511):

Where also it hath been the custom in the villages to ring *pro pace* in the morning or the evening, there the pastors shall let it still remain; yet they shall withal admonish the people that they then pray God earnestly and diligently for temporal peace, and also give thanks for all grace and benefits, since the abuse with the Ave Maria hath been done away; for such ringing is not held for a divine service, as it once was, but that thereby the people be admonished to thanksgiving and, as aforesaid, to pray for peace, and thereby to know the division of the day. Where also Thomas Müntzer abolished the ringing to the sermon, there one shall begin it again as was done of old, and not leave it off

The Palatinate 1546: peace, workers and the Passion. Kurpfalz, provisional *Kirchenordnung*, 1546 (Sehling 14, p. 96):

It seemeth also profitable that the bell be rung *pro pace* morning and evening, as the ancients also did, and that the people be thereby reminded to pray God for the common peace, and also that the day-labourers go to and from their work at such a sign; item, that the bell be rung at midday at eleven, or at the least on Friday, to remind the people of the sufferings of Christ.

Noon and the Turk. Wolfenbüttel moves the *pro pace* to eleven o'clock daily, as a prayer for peace, good government and against the Turk. **Wolfenbüttel, *Kirchenordnung*, 1543** (Sehling 6/1, p. 71):

Pro pace. Every midday, when the clock striketh eleven, one shall strike or ring the bell in every parish church *pro pace*; that is, that the people be thereby admonished to pray God for peace and good government, whereby we also pray for the magistrates against our enemies, against the Turk, etc., wherein much lieth for us.

The three daily prayer bells. Lüneburg and Hoya ring morning, noon and evening. **Lüneburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1564** (Sehling 6/1, p. 552):

Since it is also customary that the prayer bells be rung at evening, morning and midday, the people shall be admonished, when that is done, to make their prayer to God the Lord for peace and all temporal and eternal welfare, and to hold their household thereto also, whether they be in the house, in the field, or wherever one is, and that they be not ashamed of it

Hoya gives the prayer to be said "upon the ringing *pro pace*". **Hoya, *Kirchenordnung*, 1581** (Sehling 6/2, p. 1143):

Keep us, dear heavenly Father, and thy whole Christendom, this day or night and at all times, from all evil, from the threatenings of the wretched devil, from a sudden, evil, unforeseen death, from grievous plague of our body, from fire and flood, and from all our enemies, as the Turks, Muscovites, the pope and all heretics and tyrants, and from all danger. Graciously grant thy blessing and peace to thy children; preserve also our pastors and magistrates, together with all householders, that we may rightly know, fear and trust thee, live in rest and peace, and feel thy blessing among us. Amen

The Ave and Salve abolished or recast.

- **Coburg 1554/55**: the three pulses morning and evening "which in the papacy were called the Ave Maria and Salve" are to cease, with the weather-ringing, "so that we be not counted papistical"; but the magistrate may have one pulse rung for workers or for shutting the gates. **Coburg, *Vorschaffung* of the visitation, 1554/55** (Sehling 1, p. 544):

Seventhly, that the three pulses with the bell morning and evening, which in the papacy were called the Ave Maria and Salve, shall cease for the sake of strangers and neighbouring folk, so that we be not counted papistical; likewise the ringing for the weather. But if the magistrates would have one pulse rung at the morning hour for the sake of the working people, or for the shutting of the gates, it shall be free to them.

- **Heilbronn 1532**: the council abolished the evening *Salve* but kept the ringing at the same hour, followed by singing and prayer for peace, with a sign rung on the prayer bell. **Heilbronn, *Gottesdienstordnung*, 1532** (Sehling 17/1, p. 305):

Whereas an honourable council hath abolished the *Salve* at eventide, their wisdom hath [ordered] in its stead that every working day at the same evening hour one ring as hitherto to the *Salve*, and, when it hath been rung out, the Latin and German schoolmasters or their deputies and scholars shall appear to hold a song for the common peace; a deacon also shall appear thereat and admonish the people present to pray for the common peace; [and] in the midst of such prayer a sign shall be rung with the prayer bell, as hitherto.

- **Lichtenberg 1579**: the Ave bell is no longer to be a threefold pulse but one continuous pulse, a plain morning and evening bell. **Lichtenberg, *Dienstanweisung für die Pfarrer des Amtes Lichtenberg*, 1579** (Sehling 18, p. 377):

Sixthly, the Ave Maria ringing, as it is called, shall henceforth be not a threefold but a continuous pulse, that it be held for a morning and evening bell or ringing.

The Friday bell for the Passion. The Friday ringing at the hour of the crucifixion was kept by some orders, as at the Palatinate in 1546 (above). **Thüngen, *Kirchenordnung*, 1564** (Sehling 11, p. 741), having abolished weather-ringing:

But the ringing which is done on Friday in remembrance of the suffering and death of Christ is not to be rejected; and what all and every Christian is to call to mind thereby shall be set forth more at large, at a fitting time, by the pastor.

Hohenlohe 1582, on the other hand, abolishes the Friday *Tenebrae* ringing outright and puts a ringing to the Friday litany in its place (§9.5.5).

Other examples.

- **Breslau 1585**: in time of plague the council asks those in the street, when the evening *pro pace* is rung, to kneel and pray, and orders the ringing lengthened (Sehling 3, pp. 405–406).
- **Lippe 1571**: the prayer bell at morning, noon and evening is kept "for many moving reasons", but not as though it must be kept; where it has lapsed it need not be restored. The preachers are to explain where the *pro pace* ringing came from,

and how it fell into abuse under the papacy "as if it were a service done to the Virgin Mary" (Sehling 21, p. 442).

9.5.4 Bells within the Mass

The question. In the Roman Mass a small bell (*Schelle*, *campanula* [little bell]) was rung at the Sanctus and at the elevation of the host and chalice, and the tower bell was often tolled as well. The evangelical orders dropped the Canon, but several kept the elevation for a time, and some kept the bell with it.

A bell sign before the consecration. The earliest Prussian and Livonian orders keep a sign with the little bell between the Preface and the consecration:

- **Prussia, *Artikel der Ceremonien*, 1525** (Sehling 4, p. 32):

Upon the finished Preface and consecration a sign is given with the little bell; thereafter straightway the priest elevateth both parts of the Sacrament, without interval, one after the other. Meanwhile, and as soon as the Preface together with the evangelical blessing is ended, the choir singeth the Sanctus in German or Latin as occasion serveth, with few notes.

- **Riga, *Kirchenordnung*, 1530** (Sehling 5, p. 16):

Upon the sermon followeth the Preface, which the priest singeth in German as far as the *per Christum* (through Christ), inclusive. Then let a sign be given straightway with a little bell. Thereafter straightway shall the priest first take the bread upon the paten into his hand, and turn himself at the altar to the people, and speak the words of blessing or consecration well aloud, in German and distinctly.

- **Kurland, *Kirchenordnung*, 1570** (Sehling 5, p. 90):

Upon the Preface followeth the consecration toward the people, when the sign with the little bell hath been given. Straightway the choir singeth the Sanctus, *Jesaia dem Propheten* (To Isaiah the prophet), etc.

Ringing at the elevation. The Danish *Ordinatio* (Ordinance) of 1537, which stands behind the Schleswig-Holstein order of 1542, leaves the elevation to the minister's liberty, "the bells meanwhile sounding according to custom". **Denmark, *Ordinatio ecclesiastica*, 1537, from Sehling's apparatus** (Sehling 23, p. 90):

And forthwith after the words let him elevate with a seemly elevation, if it so seem good to the minister, the bells meanwhile sounding according to custom. For in these things Christian liberty is to be kept; yet so that the people be sufficiently forewarned of it beforehand, and that nothing of these things be changed without the consent and command of the superintendent.

Under the Interim the Ansbach *Auctuarium* ordered both the elevation and the bell. **Brandenburg-Ansbach, *Auctuarium*, 1548** (Interim order; Sehling 11, p. 327):

Item, the priests also shall, after the customary old usage, lift up both kinds of the holy Sacrament, and have [the bell] rung or tinkled thereto.

At Hof the elevation with a threefold pulse of the bell survived until about 1560. The order of 1592 records its passing. **Hof, *Ordo ecclesiasticus*, 1592** (Sehling 11, p. 407):

But the elevation of the blessed bread and wine with a threefold pulse of the little bell, whereby our forefathers were moved to notable piety, beating their breasts and bending their knees before Christ the Saviour, whom they beheld as it were veiled in the bread and wine, was abrogated almost thirty years ago, Dr Johann Streitberger being then pastor, because this ceremony no longer had place in the other churches of the margraviate.

Anhalt in 1568 still kept the elevation on high feasts, without mention of a bell (Sehling 2, p. 570; quoted in Chapter 12, §12.10.6).

A bell to call the communicants. Two orders ring a bell in the Mass to call the communicants forward. At Hatzkerode the sign is given *during the German Sanctus*. This is the only bell in the corpus rung at the Sanctus. **Hatzkerode, *Kirchenordnunge*, 1534(?)** (Sehling 2, p. 587):

After the sermon is done, a German song or the German Sanctus, *Jesaia dem Propheten*, shall be sung, as it pleaseth the pastor. Meanwhile a sign shall be given with the bell; then shall the communicants go into the choir, and the men stand on the right, the

women and maidens on the left.

Haldensleben, *Ordo caeremoniarum ecclesiae Haldenslebensis*, 1564 (Sehling 2, p. 457):

6. But after the sermon those who are to communicate come to the altar, called together by the custos with a certain little bell.

A choir bell. At Königsberg in 1568 "the little bell in the choir" is rung after the early sermon to call the cantor and scholars (§9.5.5).

The Sacrament to the sick. The medieval viaticum went through the streets with light and bell. The orders divide:

- **Baden 1533** still has the Sacrament carried to the sick "with light and bells going before" (Sehling 16, p. 510).
- **Brandenburg-Ansbach 1556** lets a sign be given with the bell, "yet distinctly", when the minister goes to the sick (Sehling 11, p. 336, quoted in §9.5.7). The editor notes that this is neither the passing bell nor the Catholic bell that called the faithful to follow the Sacrament.
- **Transylvania 1543**: the minister goes to the sick "without candles, little bells and other pomp, which entice the unlearned to idolatry" (Sehling 24, p. 196).
- **Micron 1554/1565** (Reformed) rejects "altars, lights, little bells, vestments" altogether. **Micron, *Ordinancien* (1554), East Frisian German edition, 1565** (Reformed; Sehling 7/1, p. 615):

[we] have therefore in no wise received such ceremonies as are vain and unprofitable, or draw to any idolatry and darken Christ Jesus in his priesthood: as are altars, lights, little bells, vestments, to which some mystery is ascribed, and whatever more such things there be.

Not found. The corpus has:

- **No Sanctus bell as such.** The word *Sanctusglocke* (or any compound of it) does not occur. The Hatzkerode bell during the German Sanctus calls the communicants; it does not mark the Sanctus.
- **No ringing during the Lord's Prayer in the Mass.** The Lord's Prayer is tied to bells only outside the Mass: the daily prayer bells (§9.5.3), and the Friday bell at eleven, at which, according to a later folk custom cited by the Hohenlohe editor, those in the field said an Our Father (Sehling 15, p. 452, editor's note).
- **No ringing at the *Gloria in excelsis*, at Easter or otherwise.** The festal bells of Easter belong to the summons and the chiming of the feast (§9.5.1), not to the Gloria.
- **No altar bell at the words of institution** after the elevation fell away. The bell before the consecration survives only in Prussia 1525, Riga 1530 and Kurland 1570.

9.5.5 Bells at the *Te Deum*, the litany and other chants

Ringing during the *Te Deum*. In Prussia the bell was rung during the German *Te Deum* (We praise thee, O God) at the end of Matins, to summon the people to the sermon and the Mass that followed. **Prussia, *Kirchenordnung*, 1544** (Sehling 4, p. 67):

thereupon the deacon or minister of the church maketh a short exhortation concerning the holy Sacrament for those who will communicate, in the stead of a chapter; upon the exhortation the whole church singeth the German *Te Deum laudamus* (We praise thee, O God), under which the bell is rung to the sermon, and the song *Jesus Christus unser Heiland* (Jesus Christ our Saviour) is sung before the sermon.

The Prussian order of 1568 repeats it, and adds a choir bell. **Prussia, *Kirchenordnung und Ceremonien*, 1568** (Sehling 4, p. 79):

As soon as this sermon is concluded, one shall ring with the little bell in the choir, and the cantor with the school assistants and boys shall betake themselves into the church. […] After the Creed a boy readeth a lesson below before the altar toward the people, as all lessons shall be read, and thereupon followeth the *Benedictus Dominus Deus Israel* (Blessed be the Lord God of Israel) with the antiphon, or Luther's German *Te Deum laudamus*, *O Gott, dich loben wir, o Gott, wir danken dir* (O God, we praise thee, O God, we thank thee), etc. Meanwhile one ringeth again with the great bell, and the whole church singeth after the *Benedictus* or *Te Deum laudamus*: *Wir glauben* (We believe), etc.

All the bells at the Christmas *Te Deum*. At Hof's Christmas Matins the organ plays the responsory, the German *Te Deum* alternates between organ and choir, and all the bells are rung until it ends. **Hof, *Ordo ecclesiasticus*, 1592, Christmas Day**

(Sehling 11, p. 413):

II. The lesson from the New Testament. This being finished, the organist playeth the responsory in the customary manner, the choir following: *Verbum caro factum est* (The Word was made flesh). Straightway the sermon is held. After it cometh the canticle of Saints Ambrose and Augustine in German, *Herr Gott, dich loben wir* (Lord God, we praise thee). The organist beginning, the whole choir followeth, and so the song is finished in turns. During this song one ringeth with all the bells until the end of the same.

The litany. Hohenlohe rings the largest bell when the Friday litany begins, so that those in the field and at home may join in the prayer, and abolishes the *Tenebrae* ringing. **Hohenlohe, *Kirchen- und Schulordnung*, 1582** (Sehling 15, p. 452):

[12.] Of the ringing of the *Tenebrae* on Friday. Forasmuch as not every one can come to the common prayer on Friday, but [some] are kept from it by necessary business in the field, as also the hired day-labourers, we will, ordain and command that, as soon as the litany is begun, a good sign be rung with the greatest bell, whereby every one in the field or in the houses may be reminded of the common prayer; to the end that, although they be not present in body with the assembled congregation in the church, they may yet not be separated from it in spirit and in devout prayer, but be admonished thereto. On the other hand the *Tenebrae* ringing shall be wholly abolished in all churches and in all places in our county, and no longer be permitted.

At Regensburg the litany is sung *under* the ringing, while the people gather for the early sermon and communion. **Regensburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1567** (Sehling 13, p. 461):

First, in both churches, the New Parish and St Oswald's, the Prussian litany, or something German of the season, is sung by the German schools and the congregation under the ringing.

Hymn stanzas. No order prescribes ringing during a particular stanza of a hymn. What the orders have instead is ringing during a whole chant that ends one part of the service and leads into the next: the *Te Deum* at Matins (Prussia, Hof), the litany (Hohenlohe, Regensburg). The Hohenlohe editor records a later folk custom of ringing on Good Friday while "O Lamm Gottes" (O Lamb of God) was sung (Sehling 15, p. 452, editor's note), but that is nineteenth-century evidence and is not in the order.

The Litany itself is treated in Chapter 13, §13.21.

9.5.6 Bells for the dead

Ringing at a death, as a reminder to the living. The Saxon visitors kept the bell rung for the dead, but gave it a new reason. **Meissen, *Ordnung der Visitatoren für die Stadt Meissen*, 1540** (Sehling 2, p. 52):

Of ringing when any one hath died. The bell shall be rung for the dead, that the living also may consider the hour and time of their own dying, and amend their life, etc. This announcing with the bell shall be done soon after their death. Also henceforth the bell shall be rung *pro pace* (for peace) early and at evening, as hath been done hitherto, that the people be reminded to pray for a common peace of Christendom. Ringing-money for the dead. The ringing-money shall go to the sexton, as it hath been given of old.

Saturday ringing for the souls abolished. The weekly ringing "for all faithful souls" went:

- **Zwickau, *Verordnung der Visitatoren*, 1529** (Sehling 1, p. 721):

To the sermon, Mass and Vespers, also for the dead, one may ring; yet so that to Vespers and for the dead, also early to the lesson, it remain at one ringing with one bell. Likewise one may ring *pro pace*, yet so that the people be well instructed therein. […] The ringing for the souls on Saturday shall cease.

- **Reuss, *Kirchen-Ordnung* of Heinrich IV, 1552** (Sehling 2, p. 156), which in the same article abolishes weather-ringing:

Weather-ringing. This article was specially dealt with, and it was resolved with one accord that, since the ringing breedeth disorder in many places, it also shall be and remain done away everywhere; yet this shall be diligently forewarned of from the pulpits, and the people, without it, faithfully admonished at all times to prayer. The ringing on Saturday for all faithful souls shall also be abolished, for it is offensive and smelleth of the papacy.

Equality and fees. Ulm's undated visitation articles of the early 1530s (Moderate Reformed) ask "that in the ringing in memory of the dead equality be kept" (Sehling 17/2, p. 193). In practice the number of bells was a matter of fees. Danzig's burial order of

1578 sets the schoolboys' pay by the bells rung. **Danzig, *Begräbnisordnung*, 1578** (Sehling 4, p. 191):

that at the stroke of two in the afternoon the scholars shall begin to sing before the doors until half past two, and for that they shall be given, when one bell is rung, ten groschen; for two bells, twenty groschen; and when all the bells are rung, 40 groschen.

Not during the sermon. Herford 1532 silences "all bells, be it for the dead or not" while the sermon is preached (§9.4.4).

Burial without bells. The bell was withheld as a mark of exclusion or of grief:

- **The despisers of the Sacrament. Zwickau, *Verordnung der Visitatoren*, 1533** (Sehling 1, p. 723):

If also any one were so stiff-necked and rude that, over and against admonition and threatening given, he went not to church, nor heard God's word, nor received the most worthy Sacrament in his health, nor desired it in his sickness, and so died without the most worthy Sacrament, him shall one bury in silence, without bells and without escort of the scholars.

- **Unbaptized infants. Lippe, *Kirchenordnung*, 1571** (Sehling 21, p. 432), which buries them in the churchyard "for the comfort of the sorrowing parents", but without bells:

But they shall be buried, for the comfort of the sorrowing parents, in the churchyards or burial places of other Christians and baptized children; yet without ringing of bells and singing of the ministers of the church and scholars: not in the meaning that we condemn the little unbaptized children, especially those born of godly, Christian-believing parents in holy wedlock

Limpurg 1610, by contrast, rings "the small bell" for children carried to burial "before or after baptism" in its village of Münster (Sehling 16, p. 623).

9.5.7 Bells at baptisms and weddings

Baptism. Where a child was baptized outside the regular service, a bell called the congregation to witness it:

- **Kurpfalz, *Kirchenordnung*, 1556** (Sehling 14, p. 121):

We hold it also profitable, if a child is to be baptized outside the common sermon or assembly of the church, as was mentioned a little before, that a sign be given with a bell, that other people may thereby be admonished to come to the act of baptism.

- **Brandenburg-Ansbach, *Vereinbarungen der Theologen auf der Synode*, 1556** (Sehling 11, p. 336):

But when one baptizeth in church, one shall ring thereto with the little bell, and leave out the sign of the cross. […] With the sick no surplice [is] to be used, *yet let it be free in their places*; and (yet distinctly) a sign [is] to be given with the bell.

- **Limpurg 1610** settles a complaint by ordering the ringing before baptism with the small bell in all country churches. **Limpurg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1610** (Sehling 16, p. 623):

1. Of the ringing at the baptism of children. Such ringing shall henceforth be done and performed in the country at all churches (except the town of Gaildorf), whether it was in use before in one place or another or not, before the baptism, with the small bell.

- **Heilbronn**, around 1529, kept the bell for "child baptism" when it stopped ringing for the Mass and Vespers (Sehling 17/1, p. 226, editor's introduction).

The Regensburg editor notes that a bell for baptism was unknown in the Middle Ages (Sehling 13, p. 436, editor's note), so this is a new evangelical use, not a survival.

Weddings. At Hof the bell for a wedding service is rung half an hour later than usual. **Hof, *Ordo ecclesiasticus*, 1592** (Sehling 11, p. 430):

When there is a wedding, the bell is rung half an hour later than is otherwise customary

9.5.8 Bells against storms

The abolition of weather-ringing, with the bell baptism behind it, is treated in Chapter 13, §13.15.5, which quotes Saxony 1528 and 1580 and summarizes Hohenlohe 1582 and the other territories. The orders fall into three groups:

- **Kept, re-explained as a call to prayer**: Saxony 1528 (Sehling 1, pp. 170–171), the Upper Palatinate 1579 (one bell at night), Hohenlohe 1582 (one bell, not all, and not as long as the storm lasts), Limpurg 1610 (the great bell only, for a quarter of an hour).
- **Abolished**: Ulm (undated articles, Moderate Reformed, "as it hath begun"), Reuss 1552 (§9.5.6), Coburg 1554/55 (§9.5.3), Thüngen 1564, Saxony 1580, Saxe-Lauenburg 1585 (§9.5.1), and the Oldenburg visitations of 1609–1610, which keep the prayer bell instead (Sehling 7/2.1, p. 1212).
- **Asked about at visitation**: Hohenlohe 1558 asks whether there is ringing against weather, fog, frost or heat (Sehling 15, p. 122).

9.5.9 Lesser signals: the sermon glass and the alms bell

The end of the sermon. At Zerbst the sexton turned an hour-glass when the preacher went up into the pulpit, and rang a little bell when it had run out. **Zerbst, *Vereinbarungen des gesammten Ministeriums*, 1545** (Sehling 2, p. 593):

But that this may be kept, a three-quarter-hour glass shall stand before the pulpit, that the preacher may see when he should conclude; and the sexton also shall keep by him two glasses, one of an hour, the other of three quarters of an hour, and use the hour-glass at High Mass and the three-quarter glass at all other sermons, and turn it as soon as the preacher goeth up into the pulpit; and when the glass of one hour or of three quarters hath run out, he shall tinkle with a little bell appointed thereto, that the preacher may conclude and dismiss the congregation.

The alms bell. At Brandis the churchwardens, or someone they appoint, go round "under all sermons, or before and after," with a little bell to collect alms. **Brandis, *Ordnung für die Stadt Brandis*, 1529** (Sehling 1, p. 533):

thereto they shall go about, or appoint someone to go, with a little hand-bell during all the sermons, or else before and after, and ask the alms of the people, as at Grimma and elsewhere, and distribute it again to the poor, as aforesaid.

The Württemberg common-chest orders give the street collectors for the poor "a bell or little bell, whereby every one may be reminded to give alms" (Sehling 16, p. 96; repeated at Sehling 16, p. 202, and Sehling 6/1, p. 263). This was a street bell, not a church bell.

9.6 Table by order

Key.

- The orders are listed by date.
- "—" means that nothing on the point was found in the passages examined. It does not mean that the order forbids it.
- Each cell reports only what the order itself says. The § column gives the sections of this chapter where the evidence is quoted or cited.

Order	Vol.	Organ	Other instruments	Bells	§
Wittenberg castle church, 1525	1	Only at the Sunday *Te Deum* (We praise thee, O God) and German songs	—	A signal to singing and sermon, "not for the pomp of the feasts"	9.3.1, 9.5.1
Prussia, *Artikel der Ceremonien*, 1525	4	—	—	Sign with the little bell after Preface and consecration; elevation follows	9.5.4
Luther, *Deutsche Messe*, 1526	1	"All the organs piped", if it served the young	—	"All the bells", likewise	9.3.1

Order	Vol.	Organ	Other instruments	Bells	§
Saxony, *Unterricht der Visitatoren*, 1528	1	—	—	*Pacem* ringing kept and taught aright; weather-ringing re-explained as a call to prayer	9.5.3, 9.5.8
Hamburg, 1529	5	Four organists; silent at Passiontide; at weddings by private arrangement	Minstrels play the bridal party to the churchyard	Sextons to "strike all the bells evenly and rightly"	9.3.6, 9.4.4, 9.5.2
Zwickau, visitation, 1529	1	—	—	One bell to Vespers, the lesson and the dead; *pro pace* (for peace) allowed; Saturday ringing for souls abolished	9.5.2, 9.5.6
Brandis, 1529	1	—	—	Alms collected with a hand-bell during sermons	9.5.9
Heilbronn, c. 1529 (editor's introduction)	17/1	—	—	Sexton to ring only to the early sermon and baptism, not to Mass or Vespers	9.5.2, 9.5.7
Riga, 1530	5	—	—	Sign with a little bell before the consecration	9.5.4
Ulm, decree of 1531 (editor's introduction) (Moderate Reformed)	17/2	—	No drums, wind or strings at weddings	—	9.4.4
Heilbronn, *Gottesdienstordnung*, 1532	17/1	—	—	*Salve* abolished; evening ringing kept, with singing and prayer for peace and the prayer bell	9.5.3
Herford, 1532	21	—	Drums, trumpets and pipes silent near the church during the sermon	All bells silent during the sermon, "be it for the dead or not"	9.4.4, 9.5.6
Allstedt, visitation, 1533	1	—	—	*Pro pace* (For peace) kept, Ave Maria abolished; ringing to the sermon restored	9.5.2, 9.5.3
Altenburg castle chapter, 1533	1	—	—	One great bell on working days, more bells on Sundays and feasts	9.5.1
Baden, 1533	16	—	—	Sacrament to the sick "with light and bells"	9.5.4

Order	Vol.	Organ	Other instruments	Bells	§
Zwickau, visitation, 1533	1	—	Drumming on the church tower stopped during the sermon	Despisers of the Sacrament buried "without bells"	9.4.5, 9.5.6
Hatzkerode, 1534(?)	2	—	—	Bell sign during the German Sanctus to call communicants into the choir	9.5.4
Denmark, *Ordinatio*, 1537 (apparatus to Schleswig-Holstein 1542)	23	—	—	Elevation at liberty, "the bells meanwhile sounding according to custom"	9.5.4
Naumburg, St Wenzel, 1537/1538	2	Organ begins each German song; three or four choirs in alternation	—	—	9.3.3
Ulm, visitation articles, undated, early 1530s (Moderate Reformed)	17/2	—	—	"Equality" in ringing for the dead; weather-ringing to remain abolished	9.5.6, 9.5.8
Ansbach, mandate on figural singing, 1538	11	—	Trombones and other instruments with the psalms at court, and at weddings in church	—	9.4.1
Esslingen, *Läuteordnung*, 1540 (Moderate Reformed)	17/2	—	—	Fore-sign with the singing bell, second sign with the noon bell, then the sermon	9.5.2
Meissen, visitation, 1540	2	—	—	Death bell "that the living may consider"; *pro pace* morning and evening; ringing-money	9.5.6
Calenberg-Göttingen, 1542	6/2	Organists to set the hymns; no love-songs or worldly songs	—	—	9.3.7
Schleswig-Holstein, 1542	23	Latin Gloria alternates choir and organ; German Gloria, hymn and Creed "without organ"	—	—	9.3.3
Schönburg, 1542	2	Pieces after the Kyrie, epistle, Creed and sermon; none at communion except on high feasts; a piece after communion; *Magnificat* alternatim	—	—	9.3.4, 9.3.5

Order	Vol.	Organ	Other instruments	Bells	§
Wolfenbüttel, 1543	6/1	Organist paid by his skill; plays on Sundays; not after the sermon in the Mass	—	*Pro pace* daily at eleven	9.3.1, 9.3.6, 9.5.3
Transylvania, *Reformationsbüchlein*, 1543	24	—	—	Sick communion "without candles, little bells"	9.5.4
Prussia, *Kirchenordnung*, 1544	4	—	—	Daily morning and evening ringing kept in villages; ringing to the sermon during the German *Te Deum*	9.5.3, 9.5.5
Bergedorf, 1544	5	On feast days, only what the people have first sung through	—	—	9.3.3
Zerbst, 1545	2	—	—	Little bell when the sermon's hour-glass runs out	9.5.9
Kurpfalz, provisional order, 1546	14	—	—	*Pro pace* morning and evening, for workers too; eleven o'clock or Friday bell for the Passion	9.5.3
Bremen, *Zuchtordnung*, 1546	7/2.2	—	Council's minstrels with trumpets, pipes and drums at weddings	—	9.4.4
Brandenburg-Ansbach, *Auctuarium*, 1548 (Interim order)	11	—	—	Elevation of both kinds with ringing (Interim)	9.5.4
Reuss, 1552	2	—	—	Weather-ringing and Saturday ringing for souls abolished	9.5.6
Regensburg, Justus Jonas, 1553	13	Introit and ordinary played, not sung; communion hymns and Vespers alternatim	—	—	9.3.3
Coburg, visitation, 1554/55	1	—	—	Ave and *Salve* pulses and weather-ringing cease; a work or gate bell allowed	9.5.3
Micron, *Ordinancien*, 1554 (German 1565) (Reformed)	7/1	—	—	"Little bells" rejected with altars and lights	9.5.4
Nördlingen, St George's, 1555	12	Organ begins; three choirs; silent in Lent except the Annunciation	—	—	9.3.3, 9.3.6

Order	Vol.	Organ	Other instruments	Bells	§
Hamburg, 1556	5	Before and after the sermon and at Vespers; between the verses of the German psalm; no worldly songs	—	—	9.3.3, 9.3.5, 9.3.7
Kurpfalz, 1556	14	—	—	Bell sign for a baptism outside the service	9.5.7
Brandenburg-Ansbach, synod, 1556	11	—	—	Little bell at baptism; bell sign for the sick	9.5.4, 9.5.7
Hohenlohe, visitation, 1558	15	—	—	Asks whether there is ringing for the Ave, weather, fog, frost or heat	9.5.8
Thorn, 1560–1570	4	Baptism "not under the singing or organ"	—	—	9.3.6
Haldensleben, 1564	2	—	—	Custos's little bell calls the communicants to the altar	9.5.4
Lüneburg, 1564	6/1	—	—	Prayer bells at evening, morning and noon	9.5.3
Thüngen, 1564	11	—	—	Weather-ringing abolished; Friday Passion bell "not to be rejected"	9.5.3, 9.5.8
Regensburg, 1567	13	—	—	Litany sung "under the ringing"	9.5.5
Danzig, St Mary's, 1567	4	—	—	Ringing and chiming on feasts and vigils left off	9.5.1
Prussia, *Kirchenordnung und Ceremonien*, 1568	4	*Magnificat* alternatim; a piece after the *Nunc dimittis*	—	Little choir bell calls the scholars; great bell during the *Benedictus* or *Te Deum*	9.3.5, 9.5.3, 9.5.5
Gelnhausen, [1568]	9	Begins the *Veni Sancte Spiritus* (Come, Holy Spirit); plays the first stanza of the psalm; pieces between; closes with a piece	—	Three signs at seven, half past seven and eight	9.3.2, 9.5.2
Pomerania, *Agenda*, 1569	4	Office alternatim; at communion only three times; no worldly songs; silent in Rogation week	—	—	9.3.3, 9.3.6
Kurland, 1570	5	—	—	Little bell before the consecration	9.5.4

Order	Vol.	Organ	Other instruments	Bells	§
Nassau-Dillenburg, 1570	10	—	Wedding piping and fiddling not to disturb the sermon	—	9.4.4
Lippe, 1571	21	—	—	Prayer bell kept but not necessary; unbaptized infants buried without bells	9.5.3, 9.5.6
Stettin, visitation, 1573	4	Articles for organists: no strangers, tuning, no dances, no fantasizing over the people's singing	Organists not to act as common minstrels	—	9.3.7, 9.4.4
Reutlingen, 1574	17/2	Two stanzas sung, one played; none on communion days	—	—	9.3.3, 9.3.6
Schweinfurt, 1576	11	Organ begins Kyrie and introit; a piece in place of the *Et in terra* (And on earth)	—	—	9.3.2, 9.3.4
Emden, *Organistenvertrag*, 1577 (Reformed)	7/1	Organist to serve the organ; no galliards or dances	"Christian music and other instruments" on feasts; tower-blowing; trombone in 1579 (editor)	Carillon	9.4.2
Danzig, burial order, 1578	4	—	—	Fees by the number of bells	9.5.6
Lichtenberg, 1579	18	—	—	Ave bell a continuous, not threefold, pulse	9.5.3
Upper Palatinate, 1579	13	—	—	Weather-ringing by night with one bell, for prayer	9.5.8
Hoya, 1581	6/2	—	—	Prayer bells morning, noon and evening, with a prayer *pro pace*	9.5.3
Henneberg, 1582	2	Litany "without organ or figural music"; lower feasts without organ	—	—	9.3.6
Hohenlohe, 1582	15	—	—	Greatest bell at the Friday litany; *Tenebrae* ringing abolished; one bell in storms	9.5.5, 9.5.8
Breslau, 1585	3	—	—	Kneel in the street at the evening *pro pace* in plague-time	9.5.3

Order	Vol.	Organ	Other instruments	Bells	§
Saxe-Lauenburg, 1585	5	—	—	Bells for Word and prayer only; weather and secular ringing forbidden; sexton alone rings; a clock or compass	9.5.1, 9.5.2
Danzig, wedding ordinances, 1590/1595	4	—	Trumpets, fanfares and kettledrums forbidden at weddings	—	9.4.4
Hof, *Ordo ecclesiasticus*, 1592	11	Introit, responsory, *Te Deum* and *Magnificat* with organ; silent Advent II to Christmas Eve	—	Elevation bell ended c. 1560; all bells at the Christmas *Te Deum*; wedding bell half an hour later	9.3.2, 9.3.6, 9.5.4, 9.5.5, 9.5.7
Emden, *Kirchenordnung*, 1594 (Reformed)	7/1	Not during the singing or the service; only before and after	—	—	9.3.1
Strasbourg, 1598	20/1	Defended against the Reformed; begins at the end of the ringing; plays what is to be sung; once or twice in a hymn; freer pieces after the blessing	—	—	9.3.1, 9.3.2, 9.3.5
Bentheim-Tecklenburg, 1601 (Reformed)	22	—	—	No chiming; three times with one bell, a little bell last; burials moderate	9.5.1, 9.5.2
Nordstrand, 1605	23	—	Trumpets forbidden at weddings and feasts	—	9.4.4
Oldenburg, visitations, 1609–1610	7/2.1	—	—	Weather-ringing forbidden; prayer bell kept	9.5.8
Limpurg, 1610	16	—	—	Little bell before baptism and for children's burials; great bell a quarter-hour in storms	9.5.6, 9.5.7, 9.5.8
Danzig, *Kirchenordnung*, 1612	4	—	Town pipers and fiddlers in the choir for figural music and nuptial Masses	Seven bells named; Sunday and weekday ringing set out; chiming by rank	9.4.3, 9.5.1, 9.5.2
Schwäbisch Hall, 1543/1615	17/1	—	A fallen bride goes to church "without string-music"	—	9.4.4

Order	Vol.	Organ	Other instruments	Bells	§
Bischofswerda, 1676 (late)	2	The organist "preambulates" before each item	—	—	9.3.2

9.7 Concordance of the orders quoted

The concordance. Every order quoted in this chapter is listed below, with the volume and pages of Sehling and the sections where it is quoted. Orders cited only in summary can be found through the table in §9.6 and the text.

Order	Title	Date	Sehling	Quoted in §
Allstedt	*Ordnung der Visitatoren für die Stadt und das Amt Allstedt*	1533	1, p. 511	9.5.3
Ansbach	*Figural und coral zu ziemlicher zeit in der kirchen zu singen*	1538	11, p. 397	9.4.1
Bentheim-Tecklenburg (Reformed)	*Mandat zum Glockenläuten*	1601	22, p. 302	9.5.1
Bergedorf	*Kirchenordnung*	1544	5, p. 389	9.3.3
Brandenburg-Ansbach (Interim order)	*Auctuarium*	1548	11, p. 327	9.5.4
Brandenburg-Ansbach	*Vereinbarungen der Theologen auf der Synode*	1556	11, p. 336	9.5.7
Brandis	*Ordnung für die Stadt Brandis*	1529	1, p. 533	9.5.9
Calenberg-Göttingen	*Kirchenordnung*	1542	6/2, p. 785	9.3.7
Coburg	*Vorschaffung* of the visitation	1554/55	1, p. 544	9.5.3
Danzig	*Begräbnisordnung*	1578	4, p. 191	9.5.6
Danzig	*Kirchenordnung für Danzig*	1612	4, pp. 202–203, 212	9.4.3, 9.5.2
Denmark	*Ordinatio ecclesiastica*	1537	23, p. 90	9.5.4
Emden (Reformed)	*Organistenvertrag*	1577	7/1, pp. 475–478	9.4.2
Emden (Reformed)	*Kirchenordnung*	1594	7/1, p. 489	9.3.1
Esslingen (Moderate Reformed)	*Läuteordnung für den Predigtgottesdienst*	1540	17/2, p. 394	9.5.2
Gelnhausen	*Kirchenordnung*	[1568]	9, p. 652	9.3.2
Haldensleben	*Ordo caeremoniarum ecclesiae Haldenslebensis*	1564	2, p. 457	9.5.4
Hamburg	*Kirchenordnung*	1529	5, p. 516	9.4.4
Hamburg	*Kirchenordnung*	1556	5, p. 547	9.3.5
Hatzkerode	*Kirchenordnunge*	1534(?)	2, p. 587	9.5.4
Heilbronn	*Gottesdienstordnung*	1532	17/1, p. 305	9.5.3
Herford	*Kirchenordnung*	1532	21, p. 171	9.4.4

Order	Title	Date	Sehling	Quoted in §
Hof	*Ordo ecclesiasticus*	1592	11, pp. 407, 413, 430, 432	9.3.6, 9.5.4, 9.5.5, 9.5.7
Hohenlohe	*Kirchen- und Schulordnung*	1582	15, p. 452	9.5.5
Hoya	*Kirchenordnung*	1581	6/2, p. 1143	9.5.3
Kurland	*Kirchenordnung*	1570	5, p. 90	9.5.4
Kurpfalz	provisional *Kirchenordnung*	1546	14, p. 96	9.5.3
Kurpfalz	*Kirchenordnung*	1556	14, p. 121	9.5.7
Lichtenberg	*Dienstanweisung für die Pfarrer des Amtes Lichtenberg*	1579	18, p. 377	9.5.3
Limpurg	*Kirchenordnung*	1610	16, p. 623	9.5.7
Lippe	*Kirchenordnung*	1571	21, p. 432	9.5.6
Luther	*Deutsche Messe und ordnung gottis diensts*	1526	1, p. 11	9.3.1
Lüneburg	*Kirchenordnung*	1564	6/1, p. 552	9.5.3
Meissen	*Ordnung der Visitatoren für die Stadt Meissen*	1540	2, p. 52	9.5.6
Micron (Reformed)	*Ordinancien* (1554), East Frisian German edition	1565	7/1, p. 615	9.5.4
Nassau-Dillenburg	*Visitationsabschied*	1570	10, p. 112	9.4.4
Naumburg	*Kirchen-Ordnung* for St Wenzel	1537/1538	2, p. 72	9.3.3
Pomerania	*Agenda*	1569	4, p. 439	9.3.3
Prussia	*Artikel der Ceremonien*	1525	4, p. 32	9.5.4
Prussia	*Kirchenordnung*	1544	4, p. 67	9.5.3, 9.5.5
Prussia	*Kirchenordnung und Ceremonien*	1568	4, pp. 75, 79	9.3.5, 9.5.5
Regensburg	*Kirchenordnung* of Justus Jonas	1553	13, p. 421	9.3.3
Regensburg	*Kirchenordnung*	1567	13, p. 461	9.5.5
Reuss	*Kirchen-Ordnung* of Heinrich IV	1552	2, p. 156	9.5.6
Reutlingen	*Artikel der Schulvisitation*	1574	17/2, p. 58	9.3.3
Riga	*Kirchenordnung*	1530	5, p. 16	9.5.4
Saxe-Lauenburg	*Kirchenordnung*	1585	5, p. 423	9.5.1
Saxony (Ernestine)	*Unterricht der Visitatoren*	1528	1, p. 170	9.5.3
Schleswig-Holstein	*Kirchenordnung*	1542	23, p. 146	9.3.3
Schwäbisch Hall	*Kirchenordnung*	1543/1615	17/1, p. 155	9.4.4
Schönburg	*Kirchenordnung*	1542	2, pp. 170–171	9.3.4
Stettin	*Visitations-Abschied*	1573	4, p. 533	9.3.7
Strasbourg	*Kirchenordnung*	1598	20/1, pp. 602–603	9.3.1, 9.3.2, 9.3.5

Order	Title	Date	Sehling	Quoted in §
Thorn	*Kirchenordnung*	1560–1570	4, p. 230	9.3.6
Thüngen	*Kirchenordnung*	1564	11, p. 741	9.5.3
Wittenberg	*Wie es einer zeit mit den ceremonien der kirchen gehalten wirt*	1525	1, p. 699	9.3.1
Wolfenbüttel	*Kirchenordnung*	1543	6/1, pp. 45, 71	9.3.6, 9.5.3
Zerbst	*Vereinbarungen des gesammten Ministeriums*	1545	2, p. 593	9.5.9
Zwickau	*Verordnung der Visitatoren*	1529	1, p. 721	9.5.6
Zwickau	*Verordnung der Visitatoren*	1533	1, p. 723	9.4.5, 9.5.6

Chapter 10. The Daily Office

This chapter follows the **canonical hours** (*horae canonicae*, *die sieben Gezeiten*, *Tagzeiten*) through the evangelical church orders printed in Emil Sehling's *Die evangelischen Kirchenordnungen des XVI. Jahrhunderts* (The Evangelical Church Orders of the Sixteenth Century). The medieval cursus had eight offices:

- Matins (*Mette*, *matutinae*, with its nocturns);
- Lauds (*laudes*);
- Prime, Terce, Sext and None (the "little hours");
- Vespers;
- Compline (*completorium*).

Beside them the church sang an additional office for the departed, the **Office of the Dead** (*officium defunctorum*), which the orders call the vigil (§10.9).

The chapter asks:

- Did the Lutherans reduce the system to two offices, morning and evening, as Luther is often said to have done? Or did fuller forms survive, and where?
- Where was the system changed, and how?
- **Who** prayed the offices? Schoolboys, canons and vicars, nuns, the congregation, cathedral chapters?
- Were there **prayer obligations** on pastors, vicars or students?
- **What did the offices look like?** Do the orders set out their liturgy?
- Were they sung in **Latin, German, or both**?
- What became of the **Office of the Dead**, the vigil sung for the departed?
- What did the new **catechism service** look like? How long was it, and what was its order?
- Was the **medieval chant** kept, or were the pieces reset with new music?

How the chapter is laid out.

- §10.1 summarizes the findings, and §10.2 sets out the method and cautions.
- §10.3 gives Luther's own rulings of 1523 and 1526.
- §10.4 shows where the full cursus survived: collegiate churches and cathedrals, the remaining canons and monks, and the women's convents.
- §10.5 shows where the system was cut down to morning and evening, and why.
- §10.6 asks who prayed the offices, and what obligations were laid on whom.
- §10.7 describes the shape of the reformed offices, with the *preces*, suffrages and Litany (§10.7.5).
- §10.8 deals with language.
- §10.9 follows the Office of the Dead, the vigil sung for the departed: what it was, why and how it was abolished, and what of it survived at funerals.
- §10.10 describes the catechism service: its origins, hour and length, and its order in the Lutheran and Reformed churches, with a comparative table.
- §10.11 deals with the music.
- §10.12 gathers the ceremonial of the offices and the catechism service: kneeling, the Litany before the altar, the two choirs, the place of the lesson, the children set in order, and the sign of the cross.
- §10.13 is a table by order, and §10.14 a concordance.

10.1 Summary of findings

1. Luther did not reduce the office to two hours. He set two levels (§10.3).

- **For the parish: two daily gatherings.** In 1523 (*Von ordenung gottis diensts*, Of the order of divine service) he proposed a morning and an evening gathering of an hour each, with a Bible lesson, its exposition, psalms, responsories and antiphons. In 1526 (*Deutsche Messe*) he set out daily Matins and Vespers for "towns where there are schools", sung by the boys in Latin with a German lesson. This is the root of the Lutheran two-office pattern.

- **For chapters and convents: the full hours.** In the same year, 1523, the *Formula missae* (Form of the Mass) allowed Matins of three lessons, the little hours, Vespers and Compline *de tempore* (of the season), "nothing but the words of divine Scripture", shortened at the bishop's discretion. Luther's advice for the Saxon visitation (quoted by Sehling) was to let "convents and chapters" keep "the canonical hours and lessons". The parish schools were to sing psalms, lessons, *Benedictus*, *Magnificat*, *Te Deum* (We praise thee, O God), *Quicunque* and *Preces* morning and evening.
- **What was rejected** was "praying the seven hours" as a work "to earn grace" (*Unterricht der Visitatoren*, 1528).

2. The full cursus survived in four kinds of place (§10.4).

- **Collegiate churches and cathedrals**, in Latin, corrected *de tempore*:
  - Wittenberg castle 1525 and Altenburg 1533;
  - Ansbach 1531–1533 and Feuchtwangen 1563;
  - Goslar 1534;
  - Brandenburg 1540, under each diocese's Breviary "out of the former choir books";
  - Naumburg cathedral c. 1541;
  - Pfalz-Neuburg 1543 and Heidelberg 1546;
  - Quakenbrück 1543 and Öhringen 1556;
  - Verden cathedral 1606, on weekends and feasts.
- **Bugenhagen's order for the remaining canons and monks.** The *Pia ordinatio* (Pomerania 1535) gives a full Latin cursus "according to the number of the hours hitherto customary". It passed into Denmark 1537, Schleswig-Holstein 1542 and Braunschweig-Wolfenbüttel 1543.
- **The women's convents.** Nimbschen 1529, Spandau 1541, the Calenberg convents 1542 and Frankenberg 1542 keep the hours, purged and shortened; at Frankenberg they are voluntary. The Lüneburg convents keep all seven (1555, 1574), with a corrected Breviary of their own, the *Emendatio Breviarii virginum* of 1555. Keppel in Nassau (1570) kept all seven hours in German.
- **Breslau** (a report of 1557), where the choralists still sang the hours of the Passion and of the Visitation on weekday mornings.

3. Where the system was cut down (§10.5).

- **In the parishes.** Most town orders follow Bugenhagen (Braunschweig 1528, Hamburg 1529, Lübeck 1531, Pomerania 1535): morning and evening offices of a quarter to half an hour, sung by the school. These fold Matins, Lauds, an octonary of the Prime psalm, Vespers and on feasts Compline into two services. "With such singing … it is enough for the parish churches."
- **Freed from the hours.** Some orders free chapters and convents from the hours altogether: Lippe 1538, Mecklenburg 1552, and the Mecklenburg convents 1572.
- **Decline.** The little hours lapsed (Feuchtwangen 1563). Saxony 1580 moved the weekday office from the Latin to the German school.

4. Who prayed (§10.6).

- **Schoolboys**, above all. Their office was a school exercise in the Bible and in public speaking.
- **Canons, vicars and altarists.** Their benefices were turned into an obligation to sing the hours *de tempore* daily, on pain of losing the fief: Stendal 1540, Cölln 1540, Salzwedel 1541.
- **Nuns** in the evangelical convents, often with their pastor.
- **The congregation**: on Saturdays, Sundays and feasts, and at German Vespers in the villages.
- **No breviary obligation on pastors.** The Merseburg synod of 1544 complains that pastors "discharged of the burden of the canonical hours" think they need "neither pray nor read". It exhorts them to daily prayer and the psalter. What the orders impose on pastors is the **public** office, held "even if no one came" (Pfalz-Neuburg 1576).
- **Students for the ministry.** The Württemberg cloister schools (1559) keep *preces* at four or five, a morning office and an evening office daily. The Tübingen stipendiaries pray the psalter in course morning and evening.

5. The shape of the offices (§10.7). The orders lay the liturgy out in detail.

- **Kept**: psalms with antiphons, lessons with responsories, pure hymns, the gospel canticles, *Te Deum*, *Quicunque*, Kyrie, Our Father, collect, *Benedicamus*.

- **Cut**: saints' suffrages, homilies and legends, the *preces*, the blessings before the lessons, and in Bugenhagen even *Deus in adiutorium* (O God, make speed to save me).
- **Intercession** (§10.7.5): the full *preces* were dropped (Wittenberg 1525, Ansbach 1533), but a short kneeling form of Kyrie, Our Father and *Ostende nobis* (Show us) stayed in the Bugenhagen orders, and the Mecklenburg convents (1572) kept a full German set. Of the suffrages only those for peace, for sins and for the ruler stayed (Ansbach 1533, Transylvania 1547). Luther's Latin Litany took the place of the *Magnificat* at Saturday and eve Vespers (Pomerania 1535, 1542, 1569; Braunschweig-Wolfenbüttel 1543), and the German Litany was sung after Prime or the *Benedictus* in the convents.
- **Added**: the psalter and the Bible in course, German lessons with Dietrich's summaries, German hymns, and sermons joined to Vespers.

6. Language (§10.8).

- **Latin** in the chapters and schools. At Wittenberg 1533 the scholars were "not to sing in German, save when the people sing with them".
- **German** in the convents (Pfalz-Neuburg 1543 "to sing psalms in German in the usual tone"; Remse 1533; Keppel 1570; Mecklenburg 1572) and in the villages (Lippe 1571).
- **Both** in many towns and convents: a Latin lesson repeated in German, and Latin and German psalms in the same hour (Lüneburg 1574).

7. The Office of the Dead (§10.9). Beside the hours the medieval church sang the vigil, an office of Vespers, Matins and Lauds for the departed, endowed and paid.

- **Abolished.** No evangelical order kept it as an office for the dead. The grounds:
  - it does not help the dead (Pomesania 1524; Saxony 1528; Heilbronn 1530);
  - it abuses the psalms and Job in the service of purgatory (Pomerania 1535; Schleswig-Holstein 1542);
  - it is against God's word and the merit of Christ (Lüneburg 1527; Calenberg-Göttingen 1542);
  - it was bought and sold (Hamburg 1529; Pomerania 1535).
- **By stages.** Wittenberg (1522) moved the vigil priests' income to the common chest and set them to visit the sick. Coburg (1524) left the vigil to the families, and Ansbach (1526) kept the old foundations until a council. At Mülhausen (1528, Reformed) the preachers would keep its psalms and Job lessons in Latin, stripped of their additions and sung with understanding.
- **Chapters, convents and schools.** The chapters and convents dropped the vigils when their hours were reformed (Goslar 1534; Frankenberg 1542; Bonnus 1543). The nuns were released from psalters vowed for the dead (Braunschweig-Wolfenbüttel 1569; Mecklenburg 1572). Donauwörth (1545) freed the school from singing the vigils.
- **What survived.**
  - The name, for the singing at the grave (Ermsleben 1564). The vigil before the house of the dead was abolished only in the 1550s (Prenzlau 1557; Neubrandenburg 1559).
  - Its responsory *Credo quod Redemptor meus vivit* (I believe that my Redeemer liveth), sung before the bier (Braunschweig-Wolfenbüttel 1543; Hildesheim 1544; Pirna 1555; Rostock c. 1560), and the canticles of its Lauds (Brandenburg-Nürnberg 1533; Pfalz-Neuburg 1543).
  - At Brandenburg (1540), a short office after the burial with lessons from Job and the *Benedictus*, and a yearly service on All Souls' Day "for the good of the living".
- **What replaced it**: the procession, a mention in the next day's service and comfort for the kin (Brenz 1527), and above all the funeral sermon, "instead of the vigils" (Wittgenstein 1555).

8. The catechism service (§10.10). The Reformation added a service the old cursus did not have.

- **When.** Usually Sunday at noon or one o'clock (Mecklenburg 1552; Neckarbischofsheim 1560; Lippe 1571); sometimes early in the morning (Schwäbisch Hall 1543), inside Vespers (Naumburg 1537; Sangerhausen 1555; Thorn 1575), or as a recitation of the bare text in the morning service (Strasbourg 1548, Moderate Reformed, on the Interim; Palatinate 1563, Reformed; Saxony 1580).
- **How long.** Half an hour for the exposition or the examination (Hesse 1566, Moderate Reformed; Thorn 1575; Emden 1565 and Palatinate 1601, Reformed), an hour at most for the whole (Rostock c. 1560; Hohenlohe 1596).
- **The order.** Bell; a catechism hymn; the Our Father or a prayer; the text of the chief parts said by the pastor or recited by boys; one part expounded in course; the children examined by question and answer; a prayer, often for the children; hymn and blessing (Neckarbischofsheim 1560; Hesse 1566, Moderate Reformed; Lippe 1571).

- **The Reformed form.** The Heidelberg Catechism was divided into Sundays; the youth recited the portion and the minister expounded the next, preaching it through yearly (Palatinate 1563). Hanau (1609, Reformed) examined the young in five classes, and kept the adults back behind shut doors.

9. Music (§10.11).

- **The old chant kept.** The chapters sang from their medieval books. The old reciting and lesson tones are prescribed, including the prophecy cadence.
- **Reprinted.** From the 1540s the chant was purged and reprinted in the Lutheran antiphoners of **Spangenberg** (1545) and **Lossius** (1553/1561). Mecklenburg c. 1560, Oldenburg 1573, Lohr 1588 and Hof 1592 require them.
- **New pieces beside the old**:
  - German psalms sung to the old tones (Keppel 1570, from the Leipzig psalm-books);
  - Luther's German *Te Deum* and the German *Magnificat*;
  - polyphony at Vespers (Wittenberg 1533, Hof 1592);
  - organ alternation (Pomerania 1569, Oldenburg 1573).

10. Ceremonial (§10.12). The orders prescribe little for the body in the office.

- **Kneeling** is the one gesture they ask for: for the short *preces* after the gospel canticle (Bremen 1534), for *Veni sancte Spiritus* (Come, Holy Spirit) and *Da pacem* (Give peace) at Vespers (Pomerania 1569), for the closing collects (Stolberg-Königstein 1552), and at the opening of the Reformed morning and evening prayer (Palatinate 1563, Reformed, softened to "humble ourselves" in 1601).
- **The Litany** was sung by two to four boys kneeling before the altar, the choir and people answering (Schwarzburg 1574; Waldeck 1556; Marggrabowa 1581).
- **The choir** sang from stalls set facing, verse about verse (Mecklenburg convents 1572); the lesson was read from the pulpit, a lectern or before the altar (Coburg 1545; Herpf 1566).
- **The catechism service** has the most stage directions: the minister at the altar, the children brought into the middle of the church, boys and girls apart (Henneberg 1582), set in facing pairs or "as it were in two choirs" (Schönburg 1542; Strasbourg 1598), standing on stools to recite (Regensburg 1567), or kneeling with folded hands to pray (Heilbronn 1543).
- **Not found**: bows at the *Gloria Patri*, standing for the canticles, incense, hats, and the sign of the cross in choir. The cross survives only in the household blessing of the Small Catechism, defended in Kurland (1570) and struck from the draft in Pfalz-Zweibrücken (1557).

10.2 Scope, sources and cautions

What was searched. The `eko.db` database was searched for the office by name, in Latin, German and Low German spellings:

- *horae canonicae*, *horas canonicas* (canonical hours), *die sieben gezeiten* (the seven hours), *siben zeit* (seven hours), *Tagzeiten* (hours of the day);
- *Mette* (Matins), *matutinae* (Matins), *laudes* (Lauds), *prim* (Prime), *terz* (Terce), *sext* (Sext), *non* (None), *vesper* (Vespers), *completorium*, *complet* (Compline);
- *Brevier*, *breviarium* (breviary), *psalmodia* (psalmody);
- *precibus matutinis* (morning prayers), *preces vespertinae* (evening prayers), *frügebet* (early prayer).

It was also searched for the people who prayed the office (*Stift*, *Domkapitel*, *Vicarien*, *Klosterjungfrauen*, *Schüler*, *Stipendiaten*), for obligations (*täglich … beten*, *Psalter*), and for the books and music (*Lossius*, *Spangenberg*, *Cantional* [cantional], *Noten* [notes], *Ton* [tone], *figuraliter* [in figured music], *Orgel* [organ]). For the catechism service (§10.10) it was searched for *Katechismus* (catechism), *Kinderlehre* (children's teaching), *Kinderpredigt* (children's sermon), *Kinderfrag* (children's questioning), *examen catechismi* (examination in the catechism) and *Fragstück* (set of questions) within a short distance of *singen* (sing), *Gesang* (song), *Psalm*, *Gebet* (prayer), *Glocke* (bell), *läuten* (ring), *Uhr* (clock), *Stunde* (hour) and *Segen* (blessing). The passages were then read in context.

For the Office of the Dead (§10.9) it was searched for *Vigilie*, *Vigilien*, *vigiliae* (vigils), *officium defunctorum*, *Totenoffizium*, *Seelmesse* (requiem Mass), *Begängnis* (obsequies), *Jahrtag* (anniversary), *Dreißigster* (thirtieth [day]), *Allerseelen* and *die animarum*, for the names *Placebo* (I will please) and *Dirige* (Direct), and for the chants *Redemptor meus*, *Ego sum resurrectio* (I am the resurrection), *Si enim credimus* (For if we believe) and *lectiones ex Hiob*.

Related chapters.

- Chapter 8 covers the German hymns sung at Vespers and Matins, and the *Benedicamus*.
- Chapter 4 covers the lesson tones and the prophecy cadence (§4.5.1) and the propers of the Mass.
- Chapter 5 covers the collects of the office, the Wittenberg collect series, and the Lenten *super populum* (over the people) prayers kept at Lauds in Ansbach (§5.6.6).
- Chapter 16 covers the deacons, cantors and sextons who led the offices.
- Chapter 11 covers the Vespers sermon and the weekday sermons (§§11.4.1–11.4.3, 11.5.2), and the funeral sermon (§11.4.6).
- Chapter 13 covers the Litany (§13.21) and funerals and burial (§13.9).
- Chapter 9 covers the organ at the office and the daily prayer bells (§§9.3, 9.5.3).
- Chapter 15 covers the schoolmaster's church duties and catechesis (§§15.9, 15.11).
- Chapter 12 covers the eves and first vespers of feasts (§12.4.6).

Cautions. Four things limit what the corpus can show:

- **Church orders are not breviaries.** Sehling prints the orders, not the books the choirs sang from. Where an order says "as hitherto" or "according to the Breviary", the detail is in books outside the corpus. Of the *Emendatio Breviarii* for the Lüneburg nuns, Sehling prints only the preface.
- **Silence is not absence.** Many town orders mention Matins and Vespers only in passing. Many chapters kept their hours without any order saying so. The corpus records reforms and disputes more often than settled custom.
- **The convents and chapters are under-represented.** Their own statutes and customaries are only partly in Sehling.
- **Dates.** Several texts survive in later copies or undated. Their dates are given as Sehling gives them, with his question marks.

10.3 Luther's rulings, 1523 and 1526

10.3.1 *Von ordenung gottis diensts*, 1523: a morning and an evening gathering

Two daily gatherings. Luther's first sketch of a reformed service, written for Leisnig, starts from the office and not from the Mass. Every day there should be two gatherings: one at four or five in the morning, and one at five or six in the evening. Each is to last an hour, with a lesson read in course from the Old Testament, its exposition, and then psalms, responsories and antiphons. **Luther, *Von ordenung gottis diensts in der gemeine*, 1523** (Sehling 1, pp. 2–3):

that daily in the morning, early, at four or five, they should come together for an hour, and there let [a lesson] be read, be it scholars or priests or whosoever it be, even as the lesson is yet read at Matins. […] When now the lesson and the exposition have lasted half an hour or longer, then shall they together give thanks to God, praise him and pray for the fruit of the word, etc. For this shall be used the psalms and some good responsories [and] antiphons, briefly, so that it all be finished within one hour […]. Likewise in the evening at six or five come together again in the same manner.

Who comes. Luther did not expect the whole parish every day. Where it could not come, the office belonged to the priests and the schoolboys, above all to those who were to become preachers. They were to do it freely, not for reward. **Luther, *Von ordenung gottis diensts in der gemeine*, 1523** (Sehling 1, p. 3):

And though perchance the whole congregation could not attend such daily service, yet shall the priests and scholars, and before all those of whom we hope that good preachers and pastors shall come, do it. And let them be exhorted to do it freely, not of constraint or with unwillingness, not for reward temporal or eternal, but only to the honour of God and the profit of their neighbour.

On Sundays, by contrast, "Mass and Vespers" were to be sung for the whole congregation, with a sermon at each (Sehling 1, p. 3). The proper texts of the office were to "lie still for a time, until they be swept", above all the antiphons, responsories and collects of the saints, "for there is grievous much filth therein" (Sehling 1, p. 3).

10.3.2 *Formula missae*, 1523: the hours may stay, shortened

Not two offices but all of them. The *Formula missae* (Form of the Mass) of the same year allows much more. On weekdays, once the Masses are abolished, Luther "sees nothing that cannot be borne". Matins of three lessons, the little hours, Vespers and Compline *de tempore* (of the season) are "nothing but the words of divine Scripture". The bishop may shorten them. **Luther, *Formula missae et communionis*, 1523** (Sehling 1, p. 9):

On the other days, which we call ferias, I see nothing that may not be borne, if only the Masses be abolished. For Matins of three lessons and the hours, and Vespers and Compline *de tempore* (the feasts of the saints being excluded), are nothing but the words of divine Scripture. And it is a fair thing, yea, a needful one, that the boys be accustomed to read and to hear the psalms and the lessons of the holy Scriptures. But if anything here ought to be changed, the length may be altered at the discretion of the bishop, so that three psalms for Matins [and] three for Vespers, with one or two responsories, be gone through.

The psalter and the Bible in course. The bishop is to choose the best responsories and antiphons and order them week by week, "so that the whole psalter, distributed in parts, remain in use, and the whole Scripture, divided into lessons, continue in the ears of the church". Daily lessons are to be added, one in the morning and one in the evening, "with explanation in the vernacular" (Sehling 1, p. 9).

10.3.3 *Deutsche Messe*, 1526: a daily office for the schools

Matins and Vespers in towns with schools. The *Deutsche Messe* (German Mass) describes the weekday office as Luther wanted it "in towns where there are schools". In the morning the boys sing Latin psalms "as hitherto at Matins". Two or three boys read a chapter of the New Testament in Latin, one after another, and another boy reads it in German. A German lesson, a German hymn, the Our Father, a collect and the *Benedicamus* follow. Vespers is the same, with the Old Testament and the *Magnificat*. **Luther, *Deutsche Messe und ordnung gottis diensts*, 1526** (Sehling 1, p. 14):

For the boys and scholars, to exercise them in the Bible, it goeth thus. Daily through the week, before the lesson, they sing certain psalms in Latin, as hitherto was customary at Matins; for, as hath been said, we will keep and exercise the youth in the Latin tongue in the Bible. […] In like manner at Vespers they sing certain of the Vesper psalms, as they have hitherto been sung, also in Latin with an antiphon, thereupon a hymn, if one be at hand. […] Thereupon the *Magnificat* in Latin, with an antiphon or a hymn. Thereafter an Our Father secretly, and the collect with the *Benedicamus*. That is the daily service through the week in towns where there are schools.

What the "two offices" means. In 1526 Luther gives only Matins and Vespers, and he gives them to the school, in Latin, with a German lesson for any laymen who are present. This is the origin of the two-office pattern of the Lutheran towns (§10.5.2). But he never forbade the other hours. The *Formula missae* (Form of the Mass) had allowed them in 1523 (§10.3.2), and his advice for the Saxon visitation let the chapters and convents keep them (§10.4.1).

10.3.4 The visitors of 1528: the hours as a work

What was rejected. The *Unterricht der Visitatoren* (Instruction of the Visitors) of 1528 names "praying the seven hours" among the human ordinances made "to earn grace for our sins". In that sense they are "contrary to God" and may be dropped. **Ernestine Saxony, *Unterricht der visitatoren an die pfarrherrn*, 1528** (Sehling 1, p. 167):

The third [kind of] ordinances are made therewith to earn grace for our sins, as appointed fasts, eating no flesh on Friday, praying the seven hours, and the like. Such an opinion is against God; therefore one may also let such commandments fall […].

The text passed into Brandenburg-Nürnberg 1533 (Sehling 11, p. 171). The objection is to the hours as a **meritorious obligation**, not to singing psalms at fixed times. Rothenburg 1559 draws the distinction plainly. Its council keeps the daily "singing, praying and reading in the church", with the Latin chants, "not as was once done in the papacy with the seven hours, … as a good work to atone and pay for sins", but because "not everyone can read the holy divine Scripture" (Sehling 11, p. 591).

10.4 Where the full cursus survived

10.4.1 Luther's advice: let the chapters and convents keep the hours

For the Saxon visitation. Sehling's introduction to Ernestine Saxony prints the deliberations drawn up for the first visitation. On the collegiate churches they propose to allow "the canonical hours on ferial days, but no Masses", and they quote Luther's own

opinion. **Ernestine Saxony, deliberations for the visitation, quoted in Sehling's introduction** (Sehling 1, p. 38):

I hold it good that they be suffered (in convents and chapters) to read the canonical hours and lessons, that they be not idle, and yet abide by the Scripture and exercise themselves [therein]; only that they let the Masses go, and whatsoever more is such abomination. As the visitors also have shown. Doctor Martin Luther's opinion is also that in the parishes, morning and evening, the scholars be let sing two or three psalms and read a lesson, item the *Benedictus*, *Magnificat*, *Te Deum laudamus* (We praise thee, O God), *Quicunque vult salvus esse* (Whosoever will be saved), [and] the *Preces*, that they also abide by the Scripture.

The two levels are already here: the **full hours in chapters and convents**, and **two offices in the parishes**, sung by the school.

The Wittenberg castle church, 1525. The order for the All Saints' foundation in the castle at Wittenberg, where there was no parish, abolishes the Mass there but keeps a full Latin office. Vespers and Compline are joined: after the *Benedicamus* the psalm *Qui habitat* (Whoso dwelleth) and the *Nunc dimittis* are read without tone. Matins has a hymn verse, three psalms and three lessons from St Paul with three responsories, the *Te Deum* (We praise thee, O God), and Lauds with the *Benedictus*. The little hours keep their structure, with a lesson from the Gospels in place of the chapter. **Wittenberg, *Wie es einer zeit mit den ceremonien der kirchen gehalten wirt*, 1525** (Sehling 1, p. 699):

At Prime, Terce, Sext [and] None. Without *Deus in adiutorium* (O God, make speed to save me). Let it begin with those customary hymns; after, let the psalm *Beati immaculati* etc. be sung, and let it be divided among these four hours in the accustomed manner, with antiphons from the psalter or *de tempore* (of the season). After the antiphon, in place of the customary chapter, let a lesson be read from the evangelists, beginning with Matthew, so that one chapter be divided into four parts according to these four hours [...].

The order is explicit that all this is free: "we will that consciences be not bound by these things, as if by precept under necessity of salvation" (Sehling 1, p. 699).

10.4.2 Collegiate churches and cathedrals

Brandenburg-Ansbach, 1531–1533. The Ansbach theologians' advice of 1531 lets the canons keep all seven hours, with only "the evil, offensive and uncertain" removed. It complains that the hours had been sung "with such haste that no choir heeded or waited for the other". **Brandenburg-Ansbach-Kulmbach, *Gottesdienstmandat*, 1531** (Sehling 11, p. 312):

And their hours would yet remain to them, that is, the times of day, as Matins, Prime, Terce, Sext, None, Vespers and Compline; only the evil, offensive and uncertain would be left out, which no good-hearted man that understandeth God could blame. Now it is also known to everyone that the hours have hitherto been sung by them altogether disorderly and carelessly, with such haste that no choir heeded or waited for the other, and often the second choir began to sing before the first had finished [...].

The *Ordnung singens und lesens bei den Stiften* (Order of singing and reading in the collegiate churches) of 1533 then goes through the Breviary hour by hour (Sehling 11, pp. 313–316):

- At Matins a whole chapter of the Old Testament is divided into the three lessons, so that the Old Testament is read through "in one or two years".
- Lauds is shortened to three psalms a day, each day with its own.
- Prime, Terce, Sext and None keep their hymns and psalms. At Terce a whole chapter of the Epistles replaces the chapter, beginning with Acts.
- The *preces* are dropped every day.
- Collects that sound of the saints or of merit are struck out one by one (see Chapter 5, §5.6.6).

Brandenburg, 1540. The electoral order of Joachim II keeps the whole Latin choir office in all chapters, convents and parish churches where it was customary, "according to each bishopric's Breviary". **Brandenburg, *Kirchen-ordnung* of Joachim II, 1540** (Sehling 3, pp. 71–72):

The choir chant shall, as hitherto, in all chapters and convents, and also in the parish churches where it hath been customary, be sung and read in Latin; above all, where it is *de tempore* (of the season), nothing shall be omitted, be it Matins, Prime, Terce, Sext, None, Vespers, Compline or whatever more there is, each as it is found, according to its rubric, without any lightness. But what is *de sanctis* (of the saints) shall be looked over by us and those we appoint, and where needful corrected [...]. Otherwise shall be sung and read publicly in the churches, both early and late, according to each bishopric's Breviary, out of the former choir books [...].

Naumburg cathedral, c. 1541–1543. The cathedral chapter sent the elector an account of its daily worship. It keeps every hour and joins them to the evangelical preaching. **Naumburg, *Gottesdienst-Ordnung in der Domkirche*, 1543 (1541?), printed in Sehling's supplement** (Sehling 2, p. 596):

In the morning, in the morning prayers, are kept three psalms [and] three lessons, with responsories *de tempore* and of the feasts whose histories are grounded in holy Scripture. During the *Te Deum laudamus* (We praise thee, O God) a special bell is rung for the German lesson. After the *Te Deum laudamus* are kept the psalms of Lauds with the Canticle of Zachary, and Matins is concluded with the collect *de tempore*. Thereupon a chapter out of the Bible is read in German with a summary, and the people are exhorted to prayer, and it is concluded with a German hymn and collects. About the sixth hour Prime and Terce are kept *de tempore* [...]. About the ninth hour are kept Sext and None. The evening prayers and Compline are kept between two and three.

On Sundays and feasts "the hours, as the morning prayers, Prime, Terce, Sext, None, are kept in order one after another", and the bell for the sermon and the Lord's Supper is rung under None (Sehling 2, p. 596).

Other chapters. The full Latin cursus is kept, corrected *de tempore*, in:

- **Altenburg castle chapter, 1533**: "the seven hours ... and briefly, with only one nocturn", so that the canons "go not altogether idle"; the "pure new Litany" replaces the *preces* (Sehling 1, p. 515).
- **Goslar, St Simon and Judas, 1534**: Sehling's introduction notes that Widensee "keeps the outward form of the office": the canonical hours stay in the choir, the length is not reduced, and Latin is kept. Only the Lord's Supper is in German (Sehling 7/2.2, p. 199).
- **Pfalz-Neuburg 1543**: where chapters, convents and parishes sing "some or all of the canonical hours, daily or only on certain feasts", they shall continue (Sehling 13, p. 77). The Heidelberg chapter of the Holy Spirit followed the same text in 1546 (Sehling 14, p. 91).
- **Quakenbrück, 1543**: Hermann Bonnus's "daily exercise in the Scriptures and in singing psalms, for collegiate churches where the Gospel is preached" (Sehling 7/1, p. 229; §10.6.2).
- **Öhringen 1556**: "the old and young persons of the chapter shall sing them daily in order" (Sehling 15, p. 102).
- **Verden cathedral, 1606**: Matins and Vespers on Saturdays, Sundays and feasts, "as the old order bringeth with it", with the pure antiphons, psalms, responsories and hymns, ending "with the *Benedicamus* or Compline" (Sehling 7/1, p. 153).

10.4.3 Bugenhagen's order for the remaining canons and monks

A complete Latin cursus. Bugenhagen's *Pia ordinatio* (Pomerania 1535) has a full order of hours "according to the number of the hours hitherto customary". It was made for the monks who could not leave and for "the canons, who are now of no use to the Church of Christ". It passed into the Danish order of 1537, the Schleswig-Holstein order of 1542 (in Low German) and Braunschweig-Wolfenbüttel 1543 (Sehling 23, p. 142; 6/1, p. 81). **Pomerania, *Pia ordinatio caeremoniarum*, 1535** (Sehling 4, p. 349):

The same we say plainly of the canons, who are now of no use to the Church of Christ. They also that remain, if they be not fit for other necessary offices, may thus be exercised in these exercises of Scripture by singing, for their time. And thus may the chant with the lessons be ordered (if it so please), according to the number of the hours hitherto customary: [...]

The order then gives Matins (with Lauds), Prime, Terce, Sext, None and Vespers, and Compline recited "with a low voice without any tone" (§10.7.1). Its purpose is stated at the end: the psalms are to run on from day to day, and the whole Bible is to be read "twice or more in a year", for the consolation of those "who, hindered by age or otherwise, cannot now take up a better condition, until they render their spirit to God" (Sehling 4, p. 350).

10.4.4 The women's convents

The convents kept the hours longest. Most surviving women's houses became evangelical convents, and most of their orders keep the hours, purged and shortened:

- **Nimbschen, 1529** (Katharina von Bora's former convent): on feasts "they shall sing Matins, Prime, Terce, Sext etc." (Sehling 1, p. 617).
- **The Leipzig friaries, 1539**: the remaining friars may keep the canonical hours *de tempore* (of the season) "among themselves, yet without bells and with the church doors locked, in quiet" (Sehling 1, p. 589). The *Gemeines Fürhalten* of the

same visitation allows the religious, "until further provision", to "read or sing the seven hours, yet only *de tempore* and what is agreeable to God's word, … as a church exercise" (Sehling 1, p. 590).

- **Spandau, 1541**: the nuns' Breviary was examined by the visitors and corrected. They keep Matins (three psalms, a chapter divided into three lessons with responsories, the *Te Deum* [We praise thee, O God] and Lauds), Prime, Terce, Sext and None, and between Prime and Terce one of them reads an article of the church order or the catechism aloud in the refectory (Sehling 3, p. 305).
- **The Calenberg convents, 1542**: Lauds only on Sundays and feasts; "Prima, tertia, sexta, nona … with the customary psalms, antiphons and collects"; Vespers and Compline "with the customary psalms, antiphons, hymns" (Sehling 6/2, p. 851).
- **Frankenberg at Goslar, 1542**: a Latin order in place of the hours, which the nuns "shall do freely and not under constraint", without sin "if they keep them less exactly or even leave them off altogether" (Sehling 7/2.2, p. 277).
- **The Lüneburg convents, 1555**: all seven hours, with a corrected Breviary (below).
- **Keppel in Nassau, 1570**: all seven hours, in German (§10.8.2).

Lüneburg, 1555. The *Reformatio coenobiorum* of 1555 orders the nuns of the Lüneburg convents to meet daily for all seven hours, with the chants and lessons corrected. **Lüneburg, *Reformatio coenobiorum ducatus Luneburgensis*, 1555** (Sehling 6/1, pp. 611–612):

Thirdly, the convent virgins shall praise and honour God with reading and singing, and pray for the temporal and eternal welfare; and therefore they shall every day for some time come together in the church, and in Matins, Prime, Terce, Sext, None, Vespers and Compline sing and read the Christian chants and lessons *de tempore* and of the high feasts, and also *de sanctis* (of the saints), yet with the Christian correction and alteration, as the same are specially written down and ordained.

The "correction" is the *Emendatio Breviarii virginum ordinis Sancti Benedicti in ducatu Luneburgensi* of the same year, a revised Benedictine Breviary for the nuns. It marks what may be "read and sung piously" and what may be "omitted without any scruple of conscience" (Sehling 6/1, p. 624).

Breslau, 1557. A report of 1557 on the order of the Breslau churches says that in the Lutheran city the choralists still sang Little Hours of the medieval type every weekday morning: "the hours of the Passion of the Lord", and on Fridays "the hours of the Visitation of the Blessed Virgin Mary", before the Mass (Sehling 3, p. 405).

10.5 Where the system was cut down

10.5.1 The case against the hours

"Murmurings". The sharpest words come from Bugenhagen's *Pia ordinatio*. The monks are to be taught that Christ alone is their righteousness, and that "those murmurings of the canonical hours, and long and feigned prayers, are wearyings of the body and vexations of the conscience". **Pomerania, *Pia ordinatio caeremoniarum*, 1535** (Sehling 4, p. 345):

but that those murmurings of the canonical hours, and long and feigned prayers, are wearyings of the body and vexations of the conscience. Further, that they sing or read nothing publicly that is not taken from holy Scripture, that is, from the Old and New Testament […].

Schleswig-Holstein 1542 has the same in Low German: "the murmuring of the hours, which one calleth canonical hours" (Sehling 23, p. 131). Yet the same order goes on to give the full cursus (§10.4.3). The objection is to the hours as a burden on the conscience, not to the psalms sung in course.

What "canonical hours" ought to mean. The Hamburg order of 1529 argues that the hours took their name from the reading of canonical Scripture. Rightly understood, they would be hours of lectures on the Bible, "as now in the high school at Wittenberg". **Hamburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1529** (Sehling 5, p. 493):

So there were certain appointed hours of the day, wherein canonical Scripture was read and heard, as now in the high school at Wittenberg. At one hour the canon Peter read the canonical Scripture, at another hour the canon John, etc.; from this such appointed hours are named *horae canonicae* (canonical hours). In these so to read and to expound Scripture, that learned pastors and evangelists might be made of the hearers, were indeed rightly to read the canonical hours.

Braunschweig-Wolfenbüttel 1543 repeats the etymology: "these are also *horae canonicae*, the hours in which canonical Scripture is read and treated" (Sehling 6/1, p. 49).

"Not burdened with the canonical hours". Several territorial orders free the chapters and convents from the hours altogether, and put preaching in their place. **Mecklenburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1552** (Sehling 5, p. 196):

[They] shall also earnestly command the chapters and convents that they make themselves conformable to the parish churches, with preaching, with the communion and with other Christian ceremonies, and with the putting away of the abuses, the sacrificial Mass, the invocation of the saints, vows and cowls, etc. They shall also not be burdened with the canonical hours.

The Lippe order of 1538 has the same words in Low German: "Shall also not be burdened with the canonical hours" (Sehling 21, p. 343). The Mecklenburg convent order of 1572 frees the nuns too: "none of the virgins shall be burdened with the canonical hours *de tempore*", for true prayer "is not bound to certain times and places" and does not please God "for the sake of the work, especially when it is babbled without understanding in the Latin unknown tongue" (Sehling 5, p. 257). In its place it sets a daily German office of its own (§10.8.2).

Hours displaced by preaching. Where the old clergy kept their hours beside the evangelical preachers, the orders protect the sermon:

- **Herford 1532**: while there is preaching, "no priests shall sing or read their hours in any church" (Sehling 21, p. 170).
- **Zwickau 1545**: "the singing of the hours in the hospital of St Margaret shall be abolished". The hospital preacher is instead to sing "a psalm or spiritual song" daily with the poor and read them a lesson from the Old or New Testament (Sehling 1, p. 725).

10.5.2 Two offices, sung by the school

Bugenhagen's argument. The commonest Lutheran form is Luther's 1526 pattern: Matins and Vespers, sung daily by the Latin school. Bugenhagen's Braunschweig order of 1528 gives the reason in terms that recur at Hamburg 1529 and Lübeck 1531. The old school custom of singing psalms, antiphons and responsories helped learned men "to learning and to memory". It had been spoiled only where "the canonical hours and other things without end" were sung and left to "drunken choirboys". **Braunschweig, *Kirchenordnung*, 1528** (Sehling 6/1, p. 399):

Many that are learned must confess that it hath helped them to learning and to memory that in their youth they had to sing psalms and certain antiphons and responsories etc., which also was wont to be customary with good measure in small towns and also in great ones (as it yet is where they sing not the canonical hours and other things whereof there is no end), which also became irksome to the priests, and [was] committed to the drunken choirboys. Therefore we will have such profit for our children also, that they sing and read evening and morning every day, which is wont to be named Vespers and Matins.

Enough for a parish church. Bugenhagen's Pomeranian order of 1535 says the same in its own terms. The boys sing Latin psalms and lessons with the *Benedictus* in the morning, and psalms, lessons, a hymn and the *Magnificat* in the afternoon, each for no more than a quarter of an hour. **Pomerania, *Kirchenordnung*, 1535** (Sehling 4, p. 342):

With such singing and ceremonies it is enough for the parish churches, so that no canonical hours (!) or anything more be needed. On working days the children shall not be let sing in the church above a quarter of an hour, that they so with delight grow used to holy Scripture, and yet be not hindered thereby in their school learning [...].

The towns. Matins and Vespers in this form, or Saturday and Sunday Vespers with Sunday Matins, are the rule in the town orders:

- Wittenberg 1533 (Sehling 1, pp. 701–705);
- Saxony 1539 and 1580 (Sehling 1, pp. 564, 368);
- Senftenberg 1555 (Sehling 1, pp. 671–672);
- Prussia 1568 (Sehling 4, pp. 74–75);
- Hoya 1581, Lüneburg 1575, Pomerania 1569 (§10.7.2).

Senftenberg is typical of a small electoral town. **Senftenberg, *Kirchen-Ordnung für die Stadt Senftenberg*, 1555** (Sehling 1, pp. 671–672):

All Sundays, high feasts and holy days, in the morning early at the fifth hour, Matins shall be held as is customary, with the invitatory, psalmody, the lesson of the Gospel, a German responsory, and concluded with the *Benedicamus*. […] Also in the week on the working days, every day in the morning about the seventh hour, [there shall be] a Matins with psalmody, a German lesson out of the Old Testament, together with the *Benedictus*, collects and *Benedicamus*; and in the afternoon about the second hour a Vespers with its psalmody, a lesson out of the New Testa[ment] […]

10.5.3 Decline and transfer

Moved from the Latin school to the German school. By 1580 the Saxon visitors thought the daily office kept the Latin scholars from their studies. In the great towns, on days without a sermon, it was handed to the **German school** and reduced to a psalm, a chapter and a collect. **Saxony, *Ordnung* of Duke August, 1580** (Sehling 1, p. 370):

Where also in great towns it is the custom to keep Matins and Vespers daily on the days when there is no preaching, whereby the scholars in the Latin schools are not a little hindered in their studies, it shall henceforth, so far as the singing is concerned, be provided by the German schools; and always a psalm shall be sung before and one after, but between them a chapter out of the Bible, together with the summary, read by the deacon, and concluded with the customary collects.

The little hours fall away. At Feuchtwangen in 1563 the chapter still sang Matins and Lauds daily, but Prime, Terce, Sext and None had lapsed for some years. They clashed with the parish sermon nearby, there were no scholars to sing, and "many spoke mockingly" of them. By then the four little hours were sung in rotation, one a day. **Brandenburg-Ansbach-Kulmbach, Feuchtwangen, 1563** (Sehling 11, p. 402):

and the communicants that belong to the chapter [being] few, and moreover, many having hitherto spoken and held mockingly of such singing and reading, such hours and communion have for these causes, and not out of sloth or idleness, for some years been left off and not kept.

Other signs.

- **Torgau 1529**: the schoolmasters complained that at seven they had to sing "private hours" in the church while the school waited. The visitors gave the hours to the altarists, though the masters were to keep the stipend and help when they could (Sehling 1, p. 677).
- **The Schönburg lordships**: the "hour-priests" of the castle are to sing the hours daily "slowly and distinctly", though the reformer "would rather advise" one or two sermons in the castle "instead of such hours, since no one or very few are bettered by them". The Matins he then gives begins with "*Deus in adjutorium* in Latin" and has "*Venite*, 4 psalms in German" (Sehling 2, p. 170).
- **Mülhausen 1524** (Reformed): Sehling's introduction notes that the council left the singing of Matins, Terce and Sext to the chaplains' discretion but kept None and Vespers (Sehling 20/2, p. 163).

10.6 Who prayed the offices, and under what obligation

10.6.1 The schoolboys

The office as school exercise. In the parishes the office belonged to the Latin school. The cantor led the boys in the choir, and the boys read the lessons. The orders give two reasons, practice in the Bible and practice in public speaking. **Prussia, *Kirchenordnung und Ceremonien*, 1568** (Sehling 4, p. 75):

Thereupon shall a boy read a lesson out of the Bible in Latin in the customary tone, thus: "Lectio Isaiae prophetae, capite" etc.; and thereupon what the boy hath read in Latin shall another read in German before the choir, plainly, without tone. Such lessons serve thereto, that the dear youth may grasp a little of the text of the Bible; for it never goeth off so slightly but the dear children retain something of it. So is it also profitable to them that they learn and grow used to speak in the church before the people, according to their calling, and to perform without fear that whereunto they are required.

The school's burden was weighed against its studies:

- At Wittenberg in 1533, if the boys had sung the Mass in the morning, "they shall sing no Vespers that day, that they be not too much hindered in their studies" (Sehling 1, p. 705).
- Saxony 1580 moved the weekday office from the Latin to the German school for the same reason (§10.5.3).

10.6.2 Canons, vicars and altarists: an obligation tied to the benefice

Hours instead of Masses. Where the endowed Masses fell away but the incomes remained, the orders turned the holders of benefices into a choir for the hours. At Stendal in 1540 the vicars keep their incomes on condition that they sing the hours daily and hear the sermons and theology lectures. **Stendal, *Verordnung für die übrigen Kirchen*, 1540** (Sehling 3, p. 310):

Since now the private Masses, to which the vicars were instituted, have ceased by reason of their open and acknowledged abuse, and yet their incomes from them remain to the vicars, they shall henceforth, each in their parish churches, sing the canonical hours *de tempore* (of the season) daily, and go diligently to the sermon, and likewise attend the lectures in theology which the superintendent here shall give. On the other hand they shall let fall altogether all hours and memorials which they formerly sang and kept.

The Brandenburg town orders enforce this obligation with the loss of the benefice:

- **Cölln on the Spree, 1540**: every priest holding a benefice in the two churches is to sing the canonical hours *de tempore* daily in St Nicholas; "whatever priest refuseth this shall be deprived of his fief" (Sehling 3, p. 156).
- **Salzwedel, 1541**: all vicars and commendists resident in the town are to sing the hours daily "every morning, winter and summer, at six o'clock", on pain of losing the vicarage (Sehling 3, p. 267).

Bonnus at Quakenbrück, 1543. Hermann Bonnus gives two reasons for keeping the daily office in the collegiate churches: the holders of prebends, "that they live not wholly in idleness", and the scholars. **Stift Osnabrück, *Ordinatio Magistri Hermanni Bonni*, 1543** (Sehling 7/1, p. 229):

It is above all useful and needful to retain in the collegiate churches the exercise of holy Scripture and of the psalms: and that for the sake of the religious persons who possess prebends and ecclesiastical benefices, that they live not wholly in idleness; and then also for the sake of the scholars, whom it greatly profiteth to be diligently exercised daily in reading and singing the psalms and the holy lessons.

10.6.3 The convents and their pastors

Daily office with the pastor. In the evangelical convents the pastor often led the office. At the Cistercian convent of Leeden in Tecklenburg (1585) the conventuals and the abbess are to meet "with their pastor every day in the morning at seven o'clock in the convent church". There they say the morning prayer, sing a psalm, and hear a chapter of the Bible read and briefly expounded by the pastor (Sehling 22, p. 247). At Keppel (1570) the preacher is to teach the nuns the melodies of the German psalms (§10.11.2).

10.6.4 The congregation

Sunday and feast-day offices for all. Luther meant the weekday office for "the smaller crowd" and the Sunday Mass and Vespers for "the whole congregation" (§10.3.1). The orders follow this:

- Saturday and Sunday Vespers, Sunday Matins and festal Matins are public services, with sermon or catechism.
- On weekdays the offices are attended by whoever comes. At Naumburg the people sing a psalm with the scholars, "one verse after the other" (Sehling 2, p. 596).
- Saturday Vespers is also the hour of confession for those who will communicate. Kurland 1570 explains Saturday Vespers as the time when servants and labourers are let off work "to prepare and make themselves ready" (Sehling 5, p. 83).

Village Vespers in German. In the villages there was no Latin school, and the orders give a German Vespers led by the pastor and the sexton. **Lippe, *Kirchenordnung*, 1571** (Sehling 21, p. 395):

First, Vespers shall be begun at two o'clock on every Sunday and feast eve. And the pastor, together with his sexton and the boys whom the sexton hath with him to teach (as is now customary in the villages), shall sing a German psalm; thereupon the hymn according to the occasion of the Sundays and feasts; thereafter the Song of the Virgin Mary, and the collect or prayer, with the *Benedicamus*. But all shall be sung in German in the villages, that the simple, unskilled scholars of the sexton and the penitents in the country may grow used to the godly psalms […].

Other village provisions:

- **Prussia 1568**: "in small parishes and villages", one or two German psalms and a short catechism instruction at Vespers (Sehling 4, p. 75).
- **Lippe 1571 and Oldenburg 1573**: since there can be no Matins in the villages in winter, the pastors are to gather the people early in the morning in summer, from Easter to Michaelmas (Sehling 21, p. 396; 7/2.1, p. 1111).
- **Schwäbisch Hall 1543**: village Vespers "with a short sermon and psalms" is left to each pastor's discretion (Sehling 17/1, p. 170).

10.6.5 The pastors

No breviary obligation. No Lutheran order in the corpus binds a pastor to recite the hours privately. The *Unterricht* (Instruction) of 1528 treats "praying the seven hours" as a human ordinance that binds no conscience (§10.3.4).

An exhortation instead. The Merseburg synodal decree of 1544 noticed the result. Some pastors, "now that they are discharged of the burden of the canonical hours, think they need neither pray nor read any more". It answers with an exhortation, not a rule: daily prayer and use of the psalter. **Merseburg, synodal decree, 1544** (Sehling 2, p. 13):

and since they are now discharged of the burden of the canonical hours, they think they need from henceforth neither pray nor read; they go idle the whole week, or wait upon their livelihood […]. Therefore the pastors shall be earnestly admonished to diligent daily prayer; for if they neglect the same, they will give place to the devil, and not escape the punishment of God and of the magistrate. But especially let them exercise themselves diligently in the holy psalter, and not let it lie so despised.

The pastor's public duty. What the orders do impose on pastors is the **public** office:

- **Pfalz-Neuburg 1576**: Saturday and feast-eve Vespers must be held in towns, markets and villages. "In case that no one at all came into the church", the pastor shall still have the bell rung and read a chapter of the Bible with its summary (Sehling 13, p. 178). The order adds that this keeps him at home on Saturday evening, preparing his sermon.
- **Saxony 1580**: the deacons and preachers are to be present at "the daily early prayer" (*teglichen frügebet*) as well as the sermons (Sehling 1, p. 422).
- **Hohenlohe 1588**: in time of war the countess ordered a daily prayer service (*das alltägliche Gebet*) in every parish, and the pastors were to urge their people to attend (Sehling 15, pp. 538–550).

10.6.6 Students and future pastors

The Württemberg cloister schools, 1559. The Great Church Order of Württemberg turned the monasteries into schools for future ministers. Their day begins at four or five with *preces*: a psalm read in course by one of the students, and a Latin prayer for the Church, the emperor, the duke, the prelate and their studies. **Württemberg, *Ordnung der Klosterschulen*, 1559** (Sehling 16, pp. 365–366):

that every day, be it holy day or working day, before noon, in the morning in winter at five, but in summer after four o'clock or thereabouts, when they are roused by the convent's ringing bells, they hold *preces* together, and one of the students read with raised voice, distinctly, a psalm in order, as the order shall give it. […] Thereafter on every working day, every morning, in summer after eight, in winter at nine o'clock […], [they shall] sing two or three psalms, according as they be long or short, with the customary Christian antiphons *de tempore* (of the season), and thereupon read a whole chapter out of the Old Testament in its order from the beginning of the Bible, and conclude the same with the *Benedictus* or the Athanasian Creed, alternately one day after the other, also with the customary Christian antiphons *de tempore* and a collect.

In the afternoon a chapter of the New Testament is read, with the *Magnificat* or the *Nunc dimittis* alternately (Sehling 16, p. 366). One student is appointed each week as *hebdomadarius* for the *preces* and another for the lessons (Sehling 16, p. 367).

The Tübingen Stipendium, 1559. The ducal stipendiaries at Tübingen, the theology students who were to become Württemberg's pastors, are bound by their statutes to pray "every day, morning and evening", reciting the psalms "one or two at a time until they are finished" and then a set prayer (Sehling 17/1, p. 562). The medieval obligation of the clergy to the psalter survives here as a rule of the seminary.

10.7 The shape of the reformed offices

10.7.1 What was kept, cut and added

The orders set out the liturgy. Many orders give the office in detail, hour by hour: Wittenberg 1525, Braunschweig 1528, Ansbach 1533, Goslar 1534, Pomerania 1535, Spandau 1541, Bonnus 1543, Württemberg 1559, Keppel 1570, Lüneburg 1574. Their common features are these.

Kept:

- the **psalms** with their **antiphons**, sung in two choirs "verse by verse";
- the **lessons**, with **responsories** after them at Matins;
- the **office hymns**, if "pure";
- the **gospel canticles**: *Benedictus* at the morning office, *Magnificat* at Vespers, *Nunc dimittis* at Compline;
- the ***Te Deum*** at Sunday and festal Matins;
- the **Athanasian Creed** at Sunday Prime (Ansbach 1533, Goslar 1534, Pomerania 1535);
- the **Kyrie**, **Our Father**, the versicle *Ostende nobis* (Show us), the **collect** *de tempore* (of the season) and the ***Benedicamus***;
- the **invitatory** and *Venite* at Matins (Senftenberg 1555, Frankenberg 1542, Keppel 1570).

Cut:

- everything *de sanctis* (of the saints) that asks for the saints' intercession, with the suffrages and the Marian antiphons;
- the **homilies and legends** at Matins, replaced by Scripture;
- the **preces**, which are dropped (Wittenberg 1525, Ansbach 1533) or replaced by the Litany (Altenburg 1533), though a short form survived (§10.7.5);
- the blessings before the lessons, ***Jube, domne, benedicere*** and ***Tu autem, Domine*** (Braunschweig 1528, Pomerania 1535, Frankenberg 1542);
- in Bugenhagen's orders, even the opening ***Deus in adiutorium*** and ***Domine, labia mea*** (Wittenberg 1525, Pomerania 1535, Bonnus 1543). Bugenhagen explains in a note added in the Danish version. He does not forbid the words ("who would forbid it?"), but they are prayed "against the persecutors of the Church", and those are now the very men "who say *Deus in adiutorium* so many times a day" (Sehling 4, p. 350, n. 1);
- the **Office of the Dead**, the vigils (Pomerania 1535; §10.9).

Shortened:

- **three psalms** for Matins and three for Vespers (Luther 1523; Bugenhagen; Spandau 1541);
- **one nocturn** instead of three (Altenburg 1533; Lüneburg 1574);
- the little hours run together (Naumburg: Prime with Terce, Sext with None) or **rotated** one a day (Feuchtwangen 1563);
- Vespers and Compline **joined**, with Compline reduced to *Qui habitat* (Whoso dwelleth) and the *Nunc dimittis* read without tone (Wittenberg 1525, Pomerania 1535, Braunschweig 1528).

Added:

- the **psalter in course**, sung through in order from day to day rather than by the old weekly distribution: monthly at Feuchtwangen 1563 and in the Mecklenburg convents 1572;
- the **Bible in course** (*lectio continua*): Old Testament at Matins, New Testament at Vespers, or the reverse, read through "twice or more in a year" (Pomerania 1535), "in one or two years" (Ansbach 1533), or "the Old Testament once and the New Testament three times a year" (Mecklenburg 1572);
- a **German lesson** after the Latin one, or a German chapter with Veit Dietrich's **summaries** (Naumburg, Saxony 1580, Keppel 1570);
- **German hymns** and the German Litany, especially in the convents and village offices;
- in the evangelical towns, a **sermon** or **catechism** joined to Vespers.

10.7.2 Bible lessons in place of homilies

Pfalz-Neuburg 1543 gives the clearest rule for the Matins lessons. Where nine lessons are kept, three come from the historical books, three from the prophets, and the last three from the Epistles and the Gospel. Each day continues where the last left off. **Pfalz-Neuburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1543** (Sehling 13, pp. 77–78):

yet with this measure, that at Matins no homilies be read, but lessons out of the Bible. These may be so ordered in the chapters and convents where Matins is sung daily, that when nine lessons are kept, three be read from the historical books of the Bible, as

Moses, Joshua, Judges, Ruth, Samuel, the Kings and Chronicles, […] thereafter three from the prophets, and of the last three, the first two from the Epistles, but the third and last from the Gospel. […] And they shall so follow upon one another, that where one leaveth off today, there one shall begin again tomorrow, and so read the holy Scripture orderly one after another, always a fairly long lesson, as hath been the custom hitherto.

The chapters of Prime, Terce, Sext, None and Compline are likewise to be read in course from the Bible, "so that where one leaveth off at Prime, there one shall begin again at Terce" (Sehling 13, p. 78).

10.7.3 A complete morning office: Braunschweig, 1528

The school Matins. Bugenhagen's Braunschweig order describes the boys' daily morning office in full. Two boys intone an antiphon and a Matins psalm, and the choirs sing it with one or two more and an octonary of Psalm 119, which is the psalm of the old little hours. Three boys read the Latin lesson in the Matins tone, and a fourth reads it in German. Then follow the *Benedictus* and the closing prayers (Sehling 6/1, pp. 400–401). **Braunschweig, *Kirchenordnung*, 1528** (Sehling 6/1, p. 401):

Straightway thereupon shall the cantor alone sing the first half verse of the *Benedictus*, in the tone of the antiphon which he thinketh to sing after the *Benedictus*. The *Benedictus* shall be finished, as is customary, in both choirs. After the antiphon let the children fall on their knees, and say: *Kyrie eleison, Christe eleison, Kyrie eleison; Pater noster*. The preacher shall say: *Et ne nos* (And lead us not). *Ostende nobis, Domine, misericordiam tuam* (Show us thy mercy, O Lord). Response: *Et salutare tuum da nobis* (And grant us thy salvation). *Dominus vobiscum* (The Lord be with you). *Oremus*, with the collect. Again: *Dominus vobiscum*. Thereupon two children sing the *Benedicamus*. All this, when one is used to it, will scarcely last half an hour.

The evening office. The evening office is built the same way. It has the Vesper psalms, four Old Testament lessons, a ferial hymn ("the precious *hymni feriales*, every day one, or at times other fine hymns of Ambrose, Prudentius etc."), and the *Magnificat*. On feast eves and feasts the *Nunc dimittis* is added after the *Benedicamus*, "read slowly … without tone", followed by the Compline hymn *Jesu redemptor saeculi* (Sehling 6/1, p. 401). Matins, Lauds, the little hours, Vespers and Compline are all present in miniature, folded into two half-hour services.

10.7.4 Sunday Vespers in a Lutheran town, 1581

By the later century the town Vespers was a preaching service built on the old frame. **Hoya, *Kirchenordnung*, 1581** (Sehling 6/2, p. 1150):

On Sunday one shall ring to Vespers at one o'clock, and the schoolmaster shall go with the boys into the choir and sing three psalms of David with an antiphon. Thereupon shall a boy read a Latin lesson out of the New Testament, and next another boy [read] it in German. Thereafter the organist shall play the hymn. After the hymn a German psalm is sung. Thereupon followeth the sermon. After the sermon a German psalm is sung again, thereupon the *Magnificat*. After the *Magnificat* the collect and the *Benedicamus*.

10.7.5 The *preces*, the suffrages and the Litany

What the old office had. Three kinds of intercession closed the medieval hours. The *preces* were a chain of Kyrie, Our Father, Creed and versicles said kneeling on ferias, chiefly at Lauds, Prime, Vespers and Compline. The editor of the Ansbach order glosses them as "intercessions (as in the Litany), inserted in a set, changing manner into the several orders of prayer" (Sehling 11, p. 313, n. 10). The *suffragia* were commemorations with antiphon, versicle and collect, chiefly of the saints, added after the collect of the day. The **Litany** of the Saints belonged to Rogation and to particular days. The orders treat the three differently: the full *preces* were cut, a short form was kept, the saints' suffrages were dropped, and the Litany came in, in Luther's corrected Latin and his German, as the new common intercession.

The full preces cut. Wittenberg's castle church dropped them in 1525. **Wittenberg, *Wie es einer zeit mit den ceremonien der kirchen gehalten wirt*, 1525** (Sehling 1, p. 699):

But at Prime let the common collect be read; the *preces* (as they call them) shall be wholly left out everywhere.

The Ansbach chapters were told the same in 1533, and in the same breath given the Litany and two suffrages. **Brandenburg-Ansbach-Kulmbach, *Ordnung singens und lesens bei den Stiften*, 1533** (Sehling 11, pp. 313–314):

The *preces* they shall leave off every day. […] It seemeth good to us also that at the least once in the week, as on Friday, they hold the Litany, since Saint Paul exhorteth that one should pray for all estates, 1 Timothy 2[:1f.], that the common prayer may abide in the church also. All suffrages *de sanctis* (of the saints) they shall leave off, for they set trust in the saints, against the first commandment of God. Only on the working days they may hold the suffrages *pro pace* (for peace) and *pro peccatis* (for sins).

The short preces kept. What survived in the Bugenhagen orders was the core of the old ferial *preces*, said kneeling after the gospel canticle: *Kyrie*, Our Father, *Et ne nos* (And lead us not), the versicle *Ostende nobis* (Show us), *Dominus vobiscum* (The Lord be with you), the collect and *Benedicamus*. Braunschweig 1528 is quoted above (§10.7.3). The same chain stands in Wittenberg 1525 after the *Magnificat* (Sehling 1, p. 698), Hamburg 1529 (Sehling 5, p. 523), Lübeck 1531 (Sehling 5, p. 348), the Pomeranian *Pia ordinatio* of 1535 after the *Benedictus* (Sehling 4, p. 349), Goslar 1534 (Sehling 7/2.2, pp. 263–264), Frankenberg 1542 (Sehling 7/2.2, p. 277), Schleswig-Holstein 1542 (Sehling 23, p. 142), Braunschweig-Wolfenbüttel 1543 (Sehling 6/1, p. 50) and Hildesheim 1544 (Sehling 7/2.1, p. 849). In the parish orders the children kneel and a preacher or one of the boys says the versicle.

A full German preces: the Mecklenburg convents. The Mecklenburg convent order of 1572 kept a complete set of *preces* in German after the *Benedictus* every day: Kyrie, Creed, Our Father, and a chain of versicles for mercy, the magistrates, the clergy, the people and peace, ending in three collects. **Mecklenburg, *Klosterordnung*, 1572** (Sehling 5, pp. 258–259):

Hereupon follow these prayers through the whole year: *Kyrie eleison, Christe eleison, Kyrie eleison*; or, Lord, have mercy; Christ, have mercy; Lord, have mercy. Thereafter the virgin who began the prayer saith with a loud voice the confession of the Christian faith, I believe in God the Father etc., and the Our Father etc. The choir answereth: But deliver us from evil. The virgin: Lord, show us thy grace. The choir: And show us thy help. The virgin: Lord, help our magistrates. The choir: And hear us when we call upon thee. The virgin: Thy priests wilt thou clothe with righteousness. The choir: And thy saints shall be joyful. The virgin: Help thy people, Lord Jesus Christ. The choir: And bless that which is thine inheritance. The virgin: Grant us peace graciously, Lord God, in our days. The choir: For there is none other that could fight for us, but thou, our God, alone. The virgin: Create in us, God, a clean heart. The choir: And take not thy Holy Spirit from us. The virgin: The Lord be with you. The choir: And with thy spirit. Let us pray. Hereupon follow daily three collects: the first of the season, the other for peace, […] the third for God's word and preservation in the true faith.

The versicles are the old *preces* of Lauds and Vespers in German: *Ostende nobis*, *Domine salvum fac regem* (O Lord, save the king), *Sacerdotes tui induantur iustitia* (Let thy priests be clothed with righteousness), *Salvum fac populum tuum* (O Lord, save thy people), *Da pacem* (Give peace) and *Cor mundum* (A clean heart), with Luther's "Verleih uns Frieden" (Grant us peace) in place of *Fiat pax* (Peace be [within thy walls]). At Vespers the same order sets the Kyrie, Creed, Ten Commandments and Our Father before "*Ostende nobis domine misericordiam tuam* […] *Domine salvum fac regem* […] together with the other suffrages, in German (or in Latin, if the virgins understand it), as they are set down above at Matins" (Sehling 5, p. 259).

The saints' suffrages dropped. The Saxon visitors of 1529 close Vespers "with the customary versicles and collects, the suffrages of the saints excepted". **Belzig, *Ordnung der Stadt Belzig*, 1529** (Sehling 1, p. 527):

but thereafter the *Magnificat* with the customary versicles and collects, the *suffragia sanctorum* excepted, and some spiritual song be sung by the church.

The same clause stands in the visitation orders for Eilenburg (Sehling 1, p. 560) and Niemegk (Sehling 1, p. 616). Coburg 1545 ends Vespers with the collect of the season and *Benedicamus*, "so that all suffrages be left out" (Sehling 1, p. 543). Bonnus's order for the Osnabrück chapters (1543) puts the "the suffrages and invocations of the saints" with vigils and prayers for the dead among things "contrary to the word of God" (Sehling 7/1, p. 229).

Suffrages that stayed. Only intercessions for the living stayed. Ansbach kept *pro pace* and *pro peccatis* (above). The Transylvanian Saxons kept three suffrages, for the king, for the remission of sins and for peace, with their versicles and collects, after the Creed in the service that replaced the Mass when no one communed (Sehling 24, p. 223; Chapter 13, §13.21.1).

The suffrage for peace survived most widely as the *Da pacem* in Latin and German, with a collect *pro pace*, after the *Magnificat* (Dresden, Kreuzkirche 1574, Sehling 1, p. 555; Pomerania 1542, Sehling 4, p. 354).

The Litany at Vespers. The Litany most often took the place of the *Magnificat* or followed it, and the Saturday and feast-eve Vespers were its usual hour. Bugenhagen's Pomeranian order has the boys read Luther's Latin Litany after the Saturday Vespers lessons, but not on the eve of a feast. **Pomerania, *Kirchenordnung*, 1535** (Sehling 4, p. 340):

Straightway after the lessons shall three or four boys, as the schoolmasters will, read the Latin Litany out of Doctor Martin Luther's little song-book; and the choir shall always answer, as is set down in the song-book; thereupon the preacher readeth a collect *pro ecclesia* (for the church), and after the Amen let *Benedicamus* be sung. But at Vespers, when the next day is a special feast, one shall not read the Litany after the lessons, but sing the *Magnificat* in Latin with an antiphon.

Once a week the boys sang the German Litany with the people before the sermon instead of the office (Sehling 4, p. 342). The Pomeranian order of 1542 allows the Latin Litany in place of the *Magnificat* "when one keepeth plainly *dominicaliter*, as in Advent and Lent, and otherwise when one will", followed by the collect *pro ecclesia* and *Da pacem* (Sehling 4, p. 354). The *Agenda* of 1569 makes it monthly. **Pomerania, *Agenda*, 1569** (Sehling 4, p. 435):

Every month one shall sing at Vespers on the eve [of the holy day], once *loco Magnificat*, the German *Magnificat* with its antiphon, "Christum unsern Heiland" (Christ, our Savior) etc., and once the Latin Litany *loco Magnificat*. Thereafter the priest readeth a collect in German or Latin, and the choir closeth with the *Benedicamus*, and singeth thereupon *Da pacem, Domine* (Give peace, O Lord), on bended knees, in Latin or German.

Braunschweig-Wolfenbüttel puts the Latin Litany after the hymn at the Vespers of holy eves, sung by two or three children, and leaves the German Litany for the weekday sermon. **Brunswick- Wolfenbüttel, *Christlike kerken-ordeninge*, 1543** (Sehling 6/1, p. 51):

After the hymn shall two or three children straightway sing the Latin Litany; thereafter a collect and *Benedicamus*. But the German Litany one may let be sung once in the week after the sermon, that the whole church answer, if the parson will.

The Sunday and feast-day Vespers are to be held "without the litany" (Sehling 6/1, p. 53), and Hildesheim 1544 copies the rule (Sehling 7/2.1, pp. 850–851). Other places:

- **Wittenberg 1533**: the Latin Litany in the choir after the sermon at Saturday Vespers, closed with a Latin versicle, collect and *Benedicamus* (Sehling 1, pp. 703, 705);
- **Bremen 1534**: the German Litany after the *Magnificat* at the daily evening office of the schools (Sehling 7/2.2, p. 458);
- **Osnabrück 1543**: the German or Latin Litany at times "in the morning, also at Vespers, for all needs of body and soul that lie upon us" (Sehling 7/1, p. 256);
- **Thorn 1575**: on Fridays, in place of Vespers, on alternate weeks a figured Passion, or a figured piece followed by the Latin Litany with a collect (Sehling 4, p. 239).

The Litany at the morning office. The Litany was also joined to the morning office:

- **Hamburg 1556**: after the *Benedictus* "at times the *Quicunque vult*, at times the Litany in Latin or German *cum oratione*" (Sehling 5, p. 553);
- **Danzig 1557**: on Friday the weekday Matins "with the litanies to be sung besides" (Sehling 4, p. 181);
- **Remse 1533** (with the Altenburg convent): the nuns hold the German Litany "every week on Wednesday and Friday after the *Benedictus*, before the collect" (Sehling 1, p. 652).

The Brandenburg convents sang it after Prime. **Crevese, *Visitations-Rezess* for the Benedictine convent, 1541** (Sehling 3, p. 203):

Yet the virgins shall every Sunday, Monday, Wednesday and Friday sing the Litany, as it is to be found in the third part of the order, with all devotion in the morning after Prime, and all shall come thereto.

The visitors repeated the rule, for Monday, Wednesday and Friday, at Spandau in 1541 (Sehling 3, p. 305) and in the Salzwedel convent in 1579 (Sehling 3, p. 272).

The Litany in place of the *preces* and the *Salve*. At the Altenburg chapter in 1533 the canons were to hold "for the *preces* the pure new Litany" (§10.4.2). At Heilbronn in 1532 the evening *Salve* became "a blessing for sleep": the schoolmaster and his boys sing "a German song of praise, as the Litany, or *Mitten wir im Leben sind*, or *Da pacem Domine*", with a collect (Sehling 17/1, p. 302).

What was not found. No order keeps the Litany of the Saints with its invocations in any office, and no order uses *suffragia* in the liturgy for anything but the saints' commemorations or the three intercessions for peace, sins and the ruler. The Mass and the weekday prayer services, where the Litany was most at home, are treated in Chapter 13, §13.21.

10.8 Latin, German, or both

10.8.1 Latin: chapters, schools, and the towns

Latin for the learned. The full cursus in the chapters stayed Latin (§10.4.2):

- **Brandenburg 1540** "in Latin … according to each bishopric's Breviary";
- **Goslar 1534**, where Widensee "holds fast to the use of the Latin language" (Sehling 7/2.2, p. 199);
- **Naumburg cathedral**, with a German lesson added;
- the canons' orders of **Bugenhagen** and **Bonnus**.

The schools. The school offices were Latin by design. Luther wanted "to keep and exercise the youth in the Latin tongue in the Bible" (§10.3.3). Wittenberg 1533 forbids German singing by the boys except when the people sing with them. **Wittenberg, *Kirchen-Ordnung für die Stadt Wittenberg*, 1533** (Sehling 1, p. 703):

The schoolmaster shall not always sing one thing with the children, but divers antiphons, responsories, hymns and other chants that are taken purely out of holy Scripture. […] Distinctly and with understanding shall the psalms and lessons be read, and not sung unskilfully. In German the scholars shall not sing, save only when the people sing with them.

Understanding the Latin. Where Latin stayed, the orders tried to make it understood:

- **Braunschweig 1528**: "better diligence shall be applied, that the children learn to understand the Latin which they sing and read" (Sehling 6/1, p. 400).
- **Lohr 1588**: the Latin Vesper psalms "shall be explained in the school as far as needful, so far as it is possible to grasp them" (Sehling 11, p. 699).

10.8.2 German: convents and villages

German psalmody in the convents. Pfalz-Neuburg 1543 wants the women of the convents to psalm in German, on the old tones. **Pfalz-Neuburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1543** (Sehling 13, p. 78):

And since the whole Bible hath at this time been diligently put into German, and the psalter above all hath been so brought to light that it is clearer in German than in other tongues, the women in the convents shall learn to psalm in German in the customary tone, as they are wont [to do] in Latin, and read their lessons, chapters and collects in German, that they may be the more edified and come to a richer knowledge of God's word.

German instead of the hours. Other convent orders replace the Latin hours with a German office of psalms, a chapter and a canticle. **Kloster Remse, *Ein kurze christliche ordnung in das junkfrau closter*, 1533** (Sehling 1, p. 652):

they shall henceforth, in place of Matins, Prime, Terce, Sext [and] None, read three German psalms, a chapter out of the evangelists beginning at St Matthew, the *Benedictus* and a pure collect of the season; for Vespers likewise also three psalms, a chapter out of St Paul's epistles, beginning at that to the Romans, the *Magnificat* and a collect, all in German.

The seven hours in German. The Nassau-Dillenburg order for the convent of **Keppel (1570)** keeps all seven hours, Matins, Prime, Terce, Sext, None, Vespers and Compline, but in German. It gives the reason that the old Church divided its spiritual exercises into set times "in remembrance of the bitter passion and death of our Lord Jesus Christ". **Nassau-Dillenburg, *Ordnung für das Kloster Keppel*, 1570** (Sehling 10, p. 133):

we will that the same be still so kept, yet in the German understandable tongue, to their own and others' amendment and edification. And therefore all the convent virgins shall in the morning at the time of Matins, thereafter at Prime, Terce, Sext and None, but toward evening at the time of Vespers and Compline, go together into the choir with discipline and devotion, and at all times first sing together the antiphon "Komm, Heiliger Geist", with a German verse and the collect of the Holy Ghost.

The Matins that follows has a German *Venite*, three psalms in course "with a short summary before or after each", a German hymn "in place of the antiphon", an Old Testament lesson with Veit Dietrich's summary, and so on. On feasts the psalms and lessons are those "noted in their Breviary" (Sehling 10, pp. 133–134). Sehling's introduction notes an earlier Nassau order of 1558 that "prescribed the keeping of the seven hours in the German language" (Sehling 10, p. 31).

The Mecklenburg convents, 1572. The Mecklenburg convents read the whole psalter monthly and the Bible yearly, "in understandable German mother tongue" (Sehling 5, p. 257). Their daily office is led by the domina and the nuns in weekly turn. It opens with the German versicle "Lord, open thou my lips" and its *Gloria Patri* (Sehling 5, p. 257).

Villages. In the villages the office was German: "all shall be sung in German in the villages" (Lippe 1571, §10.6.4).

10.8.3 Both

Mixed Latin and German. Many orders mix the two languages within the same office.

- **The lessons.** Bugenhagen and his followers have the lesson read in Latin and then in German (Braunschweig 1528, Prussia 1568, Hoya 1581). Luther's *Deutsche Messe* (German Mass) had already done so (§10.3.3).
- **The parishes in Pfalz-Neuburg, 1543.** At Vespers "a whole German chapter out of the New Testament [is to be read] instead of the Latin, and concluded with a German collect". The same applies "in all the other hours that are sung in the parish churches", that "the lessons and chapters together with the collects be kept in the German tongue for the people's sake" (Sehling 13, p. 78).
- **The Lüneburg convents, 1574.** The convents mix Latin and German psalms in each hour. **Lüneburg, *Klosterordnung* of Duke Wilhelm the Younger, 1574** (Sehling 6/1, p. 620):

there shall be sung and read at Matins no more than three Latin and one German psalm, and two lessons, whereof one shall be a half or a third part of a chapter of the New Testament in German, and the collect and whatever else is customary and Christian to sing therewith. But when there are feast days, they shall sing and read four Latin and two German psalms and three lessons [...].

Prime and Terce have "a Latin and a German psalm and a collect". Sext and None have "two Latin and one German psalm and a collect". At Compline the hymn "Christe, der du bist Tag und Licht" (Christ, thou who art day and light) is sung "in German" (Sehling 6/1, p. 621). Matins is moved from midnight to four or five in the morning, "since the choir virgins grow daily older and more infirm" (Sehling 6/1, p. 620).

10.9 The Office of the Dead

Beside the eight hours of the day the medieval church sang an office for the departed, the Office of the Dead (*officium defunctorum*). The orders call it the **vigil** (*Vigilie*, *vigilia*; in Low German *vigilie*). It had three hours of its own: Vespers, Matins and Lauds. It was sung on the evening or in the night before a requiem Mass:

- before the burial;
- on the third, seventh and thirtieth days after it;
- at the anniversary.

Endowments paid for it, and priests, vicars and the school sang it. No evangelical order kept it as an office for the dead.

This section asks:

- what the orders and Sehling's editors say the vigil was (§10.9.1);
- on what grounds it was abolished (§10.9.2), and by what steps (§10.9.3);
- what became of it in the chapters, the convents and the schools (§10.9.4);
- what of it survived at funerals (§10.9.5), and what took its place (§10.9.6).

§10.9.7 gives a summary by order. The funeral as a whole is treated in Chapter 13, §13.9, the funeral sermon in Chapter 11, §11.4.6, and the bells for the dead in Chapter 9, §9.5.6.

10.9.1 What the vigil was

The orders do not describe it. They name the vigil only to abolish it, and none sets out its order. Of its content they say only that it was made of psalms and of "the words of blessed Job" (Pomerania 1535, §10.9.2), or of "the psalms and lessons out of holy Job that are sung in the vigil" (Mülhausen 1528, Reformed, §10.9.3).

Sehling's editors explain it. Their notes give this picture:

- **An office of the Breviary.** The vigil "is in this context the office of the dead, a prayer service of the Breviary, which is distinguished from the soul-Mass (*missa de requiem*) and like it was endowed to be repeated, mostly on the anniversary of the death" (Ansbach 1526, editors' note, Sehling 11, p. 94; repeated for Hohenlohe 1553, Sehling 15, p. 68).
- **Three hours.** "Since the early Middle Ages the custom had grown up in the monasteries of reading for the dead, beside the ordinary hours, a special office, which consisted of Vespers, Matins and Lauds" (Braunschweig-Wolfenbüttel 1569, editors' note, Sehling 6/1, p. 312).
- **The name.** The *vigiliae* (vigils) "are here offices of the dead held after the manner of a vigil (the eve of a higher feast)" (Nördlingen 1525, editors' note, Sehling 12, p. 305).
- **When it was sung.** The vigils were "held with antiphons, psalms and prayers in the night before the burial, at the coffin in the church, and repeated on the third, seventh and thirtieth day after the burial and on the anniversary" (Marienhafe 1593, editors' note, Sehling 7/1, p. 722). At Nuremberg the office was held "after the body had been brought into the church" (Veit Dietrich 1545, editors' note, Sehling 11, p. 528).
- **The anniversary.** "The anniversary was usually made up of the vigil and the anniversary Mass. Vigil was the name of the office of the dead held on the evening before the soul-Mass." After the office the grave was visited, if it lay in or by the church, and the Mass followed the next morning. The names of the dead were kept in "anniversary books" (Mülhausen 1524, Reformed, editors' note, Sehling 20/2, p. 197).

The Roman form. Sehling prints no text of the office. For orientation, the Roman form of it had the following (this is not from the corpus):

- Vespers is named *Placebo* (I will please) from its first antiphon, *Placebo Domino in regione vivorum* (I will please the Lord in the land of the living; Psalm 116:9), and Matins *Dirige* (Direct) from its first, *Dirige, Domine Deus meus, in conspectu tuo viam meam* (Direct my way, O Lord my God, in thy sight; Psalm 5:8).
- The nine lessons of Matins are from Job. The first responsory is *Credo quod Redemptor meus vivit* (I believe that my Redeemer liveth; Job 19:25–27).
- Lauds has the canticle of Hezekiah (Isaiah 38:10–20), and ends with the *Benedictus* and the antiphon *Ego sum resurrectio et vita* (I am the resurrection and the life; John 11:25–26).

The names *Placebo* and *Dirige* do not occur in the corpus. The responsory from Job and the canticles of Lauds reappear in the evangelical funeral (§10.9.5).

Brenz's account of its origin. Brenz explained the vigil from the first church, as a night watch at the grave that later ages took for a work for the dead. **Schwäbisch Hall, *Kirchenordnung*, 1527** (Sehling 17/1, p. 60):

Hitherto vigils and Masses have been held for the dead. This had indeed in part its good beginning in the first church, but it hath grown through self-seeking and ignorant men into an offensive abuse. For in the beginning, when one of the Christians was martyred or otherwise died, the living, out of the great love which the Christians bare one to another, abode by the grave of the martyr or of the departed a part of the night; whence it was called a *vigilia* (vigil), in German a watch. In the morning they held in the church, at the altar from which the Sacrament was given, the remembrance of the departed, commending his soul into the hands of God. This they that came after saw, and supposed that the watching or vigils were done to deliver the dead out of purgatory; whereas it was only a work of the living, showing their love toward the departed, as with us now is the going with the corpse, which bringeth indeed no profit to the dead, but is a civil work, showing love toward the departed.

Heilbronn 1530 gives the same account, in the confession that the city addressed to the Emperor (*Confessio Heilbronnensis*):

- The vigils came "out of the first church". When the dead were buried by night or early in the morning, the living watched, and were comforted "with psalms and divine sayings", that they should not grieve "as if there were no resurrection".
- Lights were burned "that one might see in the darkness", and alms were given to the poor through the deacons.
- "But such godly use of the first church is changed into an unprofitable service, to help the souls of the departed" (Sehling 17/1, pp. 278–279).

A paid office. The vigil was endowed, and those who sang it were paid:

- At Wittenberg each priest had about eight gulden a year "from the vigils which they hold" (1522; §10.9.3).
- At Mülhausen the clergy drew "presence money" for attending the anniversary Masses, the vigils and the canonical hours (editors' introduction, Sehling 20/2, p. 161). In 1528 the preachers would let the vigil psalms be sung only "without the desire of the presence money" (Sehling 20/2, p. 209).

- At Goslar the commons complained in 1525 that the presence money at the vigils for the dead had doubled, because the absent priests were counted in (editors' introduction, Sehling 7/2.2, p. 184).
- The school sang with the priests. Donauwörth in 1545 freed the schoolmaster and scholars from "the singing of the soul-Masses and vigils" (§10.9.4).

10.9.2 Why it was abolished

Luther. Luther's preface to his burial hymns of 1542 puts the evangelical case in two sentences. Sehling's editors quote it in a note to the Harlingerland order. **Harlingerland, *Kirchenordnung*, 1573/74, editors' note quoting Luther** (Sehling 7/1, p. 741):

Accordingly we have in our churches done away and clean swept out the popish abominations, as vigils, soul-Masses, *Begängnis* (obsequies), purgatory and all other jugglery practised for the dead. And we will no more let our churches be houses of wailing or places of mourning, but, as the old fathers also named them, *coemeteria*, that is, hold them for sleeping-houses and resting-places.

The orders give four grounds.

1. The dead are not helped.

- **Pomesania 1524**: "there shall henceforth be no ringing nor singing nor Mass nor vigils held over the dead; for it is of no profit to them, neither are they helped thereby". The next article forbids holding exequies or *Begängnis* over the dead, or praying for them (Sehling 4, p. 29).
- **Saxony 1528**: "if the soul-Masses, vigils and the like availed, one could put away sin by works" (Sehling 1, p. 164).
- **Heilbronn 1530**: the psalms and the prophets are given "for our comfort" by the Holy Ghost. But the dead can no longer be made fit for good by teaching and correction: "how then may that profit them which is read or sung for their sake in the vigils?" (Sehling 17/1, p. 278).
- **Wolfstein 1574**: no vigils, soul-Masses or *Begängnis* for the dead "to help the departed out of purgatory: for such is in vain" (Sehling 13, p. 586).

2. Scripture misused for purgatory. Bugenhagen made the charge in his order for the remaining canons and monks. **Pomerania, *Pia ordinatio caeremoniarum*, 1535** (Sehling 4, p. 350):

Of vigils. Let them not sing the vigils, as they call them, for the dead, since they are nothing else than an abuse of the most holy psalms and of the words of blessed Job [the print has "Joh"]; and by this abuse of the words of God nothing else is looked to than that lying and feigned purgatory. Enough hath been played for the reward of iniquity and for the bag of Judas. Henceforth let us not provoke the Lord.

- **Schleswig-Holstein 1542** repeats the ruling in Low German: the vigils are "nothing else than a misuse of the holy psalms and of the words of Saint Job" (Sehling 23, p. 144).
- **Pomerania's church order of 1535** allows nothing to be sung in the chapters and cathedrals "of purgatory and of the redemption of souls through vigils and soul-Masses" (Sehling 4, p. 342).
- **Hamburg 1529** traces the vigils to 2 Maccabees 12:43–45, where Judas sends money to Jerusalem for a sin offering for the fallen: "out of such ungrounded scripture the priests have made the most of their vigils, when they pray for the dead" (Sehling 5, p. 520).
- **The Palatinate in 1556** bids the pastors use no more "the vigils, the papal lays and other such chants, though they be in part ill drawn out of holy Scripture" (Sehling 14, p. 112).

3. Against God's word and the merit of Christ. The Lüneburg articles put the vigils with the soul-Masses, the *Kalande* (Kaland brotherhoods) and the confraternities. **Lüneburg, *Artikelbuch*, 1527** (Sehling 6/1, p. 515):

The sixteenth article. Of vigils, soul-Masses and *Kalande*. Vigils, soul-Masses, *Kalande* and the confraternities of St Mary, St James, St Anne, etc., because they are straight against God's word, shall in no wise be held. Likewise the thirtieth days and the anniversaries shall be wholly done away.

- **Calenberg-Göttingen 1542** calls the soul-Masses "with their vigils a pure abomination before God" (Sehling 6/2, p. 760).
- **Hohenlohe 1553**: soul-Masses, vigils, *Begängnisse* (obsequies) and anniversaries "diminish and darken the suffering of Christ" (Sehling 15, p. 80).

- **The Mecklenburg convent order of 1572**: "it is also open idolatry to hold *Begängnisse* for the dead. For whoso hath fallen asleep in the Lord is already blessed" (Sehling 5, p. 254).

4. Money. After purgatory the commonest charge is money: Bugenhagen's "reward of iniquity" and "bag of Judas" (above). Hamburg 1529 says that grief for the dead "went not so much to the heart of their kin that they would bring much money, until purgatory came too". Then "they had to scream the pennies out of the purses, and lords and princes gave land and people thereto" (Sehling 5, p. 520).

Elsewhere. Other orders abolish the vigils in passing, among them:

- Nördlingen 1525, which puts away "the vigils for the dead and the Masses … from the church, the sink of the former blasphemy" (Sehling 12, p. 298);
- Strasbourg 1525 (Moderate Reformed), where the council abolished the soul-Masses and vigils (editors' introduction, Sehling 20/1, p. 45);
- Minden 1530: "that vigil, memorial and soul-Mass are against the Scripture" (Sehling 21, p. 144);
- Freiberg 1537 (Sehling 1, p. 466), Lippe 1538 (Sehling 21, p. 312) and Northeim 1539 (Sehling 6/2, p. 932);
- Wurzen 1542 (Sehling 2, p. 98) and Teschen 1584 (Sehling 3, pp. 462–463).

10.9.3 By stages

The early orders moved by steps. They took the money away, left the vigil to the families, kept the old foundations for a time, or kept the texts and dropped the purpose.

Wittenberg 1522: from the vigils to the sick. The Wittenberg order of January 1522 put the priests' vigil income into the common chest and gave them a new work for it. **Wittenberg, *Kirchen-Ordnung*, 1522** (Sehling 1, p. 697):

Item, the priests whom we now have, forasmuch as their rents also are drawn into the common chest, from which each hath had yearly about eight gulden from the vigils that they hold, shall be provided with six gulden yearly; and since the Masses and vigils pass away, they may for the same money visit poor sick folk and comfort them in their need; yet they shall appoint or keep no one as executor of a testament.

Coburg 1524: left to the families. The Coburg proposal for the services ends: "With the departed it shall be as each one's kinsfolk please, how they will hold and purpose burial, vigil and soul-Mass; yet it shall be according to holy Scripture, and none shall be compelled thereto" (Coburg, *Gottesdienst-Ordnung*, 1524, Sehling 1, p. 543).

Mülhausen 1524 (Reformed): unchanged for now. The council's first order for the services left "the vigils and anniversaries … unchanged for this time" (Sehling 20/2, p. 197). The order rested on the advice of Augustin Geschmus, chaplain of St Stephen's. He would have struck the anniversary Masses and vigils altogether, since Scripture tells nothing of offices for the dead. For the sake of "the weak" he advised for the time being only joining together the vigils that fell in one week. The council, unsure of the citizens, kept them all for the present (editors' introduction, Sehling 20/2, p. 163).

Ansbach 1526: kept until a council. The margrave's diet kept the old foundations of soul-Masses, vigils and confraternities "until further action and decision of a common Christian council or national assembly, or our further answer" (Sehling 11, p. 94). No one was to be compelled to hold a *Begängnis* (obsequies; Chapter 13, §13.9.1).

Mülhausen 1528 (Reformed): the texts kept, the purpose dropped. Four years after the first order the preachers advised the council on the services. They would let the vigil's psalms and its lessons from Job stay in the church, in Latin, stripped of their additions and sung with understanding. No other text in the corpus goes so far. **Mülhausen, opinion of the people's priest and the three preachers on the services, 1528** (Reformed; Sehling 20/2, p. 209):

Thereafter the None and the Vespers, which are wont to be sung of the feria, also the *Salve*, so far as it pointeth to Christ, also the psalms and lessons out of holy Job which are sung in the vigil, without the other ungrounded additions, one may not forbid to be used in the church in Latin; yet on this condition, that it be not done as hitherto, without all faith, understanding and devotion, and with unspeakable haste and babbling, but with faith, understanding and devotion, without the desire of the presence money, but with desire toward God, and slowly, distinctly and in order.

On Sundays one of the singers was then to read or expound to the people in German what had been sung in Latin (Sehling 20/2, p. 209). The weekday None, Vespers, vigil and *Salve* were to be held in the same way (Sehling 20/2, p. 210).

Heilbronn 1529: the bell stopped. On All Souls' Day a councillor told the boy who was about to ring for the vigils in the morning to stop. The sexton was told to ring only for the early sermon and for baptisms, and never for the Mass or Vespers (editors' introduction, Sehling 17/1, pp. 225–226).

Heidelberg 1546: suspended, the rents kept. The Palatine advice on reforming the collegiate churches decided that "all vigils and soul-offices shall henceforth stand still, until amendment be undertaken in this and in other things. Yet all rents and dues shall remain with the foundation", to be shared among those who served the church (Kurpfalz, *Bedenken zur Reformation der Stiftskirchen*, 1546, Sehling 14, p. 92).

10.9.4 Chapters, convents and schools

The chapters. The vigils were above all the work of the chapters and their vicars. The orders that reformed the hours in the chapters struck the vigils in the same breath:

- **Goslar, St Simon and Judas, 1534**: the council's order for the canons' hours ends by bidding them put away "all papist ceremonies and abuses, with vigils, soul-Masses and other Masses", on pain of losing their prebends (Sehling 7/2.2, p. 264; §10.4.2).
- **Pomerania 1535**: in the chapters and cathedrals nothing may be sung of the redemption of souls "through vigils and soul-Masses" (Sehling 4, p. 342), and the *Pia ordinatio* forbids the vigils (§10.9.2).
- **Bonnus's order for the Osnabrück chapters, 1543**: "vigils and prayers for the dead … are to be wholly omitted" (Sehling 7/1, p. 229; §10.7.5).
- **Heidelberg 1546**: suspended (§10.9.3).

The convents. The reform order for the nuns of Frankenberg at Goslar sets the old offices against "their hours". **Goslar, *Ordnung für das Frauenkloster Frankenberg*, 1542** (Sehling 7/2.2, p. 275):

From this time they shall leave off all papist and monastic ceremonies, divine offices, vigils, Masses for the living and the dead, in short every abuse; but on the other hand they shall read their hours, and keep the other ceremonies, as the most honourable magistrate of Goslar hath prescribed, conformable to the divine Scriptures and to the pure and plain word.

- **The Calenberg convents, 1542**: "all corner-Masses, private Masses and soul-Masses shall be done away, with the vigils and all that hath hitherto been done for the dead, since holy Scripture maketh no mention at all of such things, and the right apostolic church knew nothing of them" (Sehling 6/2, p. 852).
- **Schaumburg, 1562**: the count bids the convents of Fischbeck and Obernkirchen leave off "forthwith the papist sacrifice-Masses, vigils, soul-Masses and all other superstitious chants and prayers that are contrary to the holy divine word" (Sehling 7/2.2, p. 60). The editors add that the convent order had forbidden the *Salve regina*, the *Regina coeli*, the vigils and the Masses for the dead (editors' introduction, Sehling 7/2.2, p. 35).

The psalter for the dead. In the convents the office of the dead went with psalters prayed for the departed, often promised under seal to the convent's benefactors. Braunschweig-Wolfenbüttel releases the nuns from such vows in its report on the monasteries of 1569. The release is spoken as Christ's own, "from heaven", to the nuns. **Braunschweig-Wolfenbüttel, *Christlicher und gründlicher bericht* on the convents, 1569** (Sehling 6/1, p. 334):

Item, if a maiden or a whole convent had promised, and had given letter and seal for it, that they would pray yearly certain psalters for a dead or a living man, I will hereby absolve them also from this vow, so that they be not bound to do it. For the psalter is not written for this, neither ordained of God thereto, that one should say it for the departed and thereby deliver them out of purgatory.

The Mecklenburg convent order of 1572 makes the same charge. The nuns had been made to sing the psalter "in an unknown Latin tongue, without all understanding and devotion", whence the proverb "thou readest even as a nun the psalter". Worse, they had sung it to "atone for their own and other folk's sins, and help the souls out of purgatory" (Sehling 5, p. 253).

The schools. The school had sung with the priests at the vigils, and the reform freed it. **Donauwörth, *Kirchenordnung*, 1545** (Sehling 12, p. 160):

So that the schoolmaster and the scholars be the less hindered in their learning, and the best time be not ill bestowed, neither schoolmaster nor scholars shall henceforth be bound to the singing of the soul-Masses and vigils.

The endowments. What had been given for the vigils went to the common chest, and the clergy who lost their fees were paid from it:

- Wittenberg 1522 (§10.9.3).
- Hamburg 1529: the preachers are to remind those who "had hitherto given money for certain Masses, vigils, wax lights" to turn it to the right service of God, "that is, to the profit of the poor and into this chest" (Sehling 5, p. 533).
- Württemberg 1536: the chest takes in all that was spent "on Masses, vigils, the eternal light" (Sehling 16, p. 96; Chapter 14, §14.5.4).
- Calenberg-Göttingen 1542: into "God's chest" falls "all that hath hitherto been ordained and founded for vigils, soul-Masses, memorials, soul-gifts, stations, candles, lights, lamps, doles and all confraternities" (instruction for the visitors, Sehling 6/2, p. 858).
- Perleberg 1542: the pastor had lost "a notable part of his living" from vigils, soul-Masses and other ceremonies. In its place he receives a measure of rye yearly and two gulden a quarter from the common chest (Sehling 3, p. 245).

10.9.5 What survived at the funeral

The office as an office did not survive. Its name, its place at the house of mourning, and some of its chants lived on in the funeral.

The name. At Ermsleben in 1564 the pastor still called the singing at the grave the vigil. **Ermsleben, *Kirchen-Ordnung der Stadt Ermsleben*, 1564** (Sehling 2, p. 486):

The dead are decently clothed, and carried honourably to the grave by the ministers of the church and all the scholars, with Latin and German songs; then they are let stand a little while by the grave, and the vigil is sung before all the people and concluded with the collect; then the corpse is set in the grave. Thereafter a short funeral sermon is made

At the house of the dead. The vigil and the night watch by the body lived on at the house of mourning. In the Mark and in Mecklenburg the vigil was still sung there in the 1550s, and the visitors abolished it:

- **Prenzlau 1557**: "Whereas hitherto the custom hath been that vigils were held before the door, but without devotion, this shall be abolished." Instead the scholars carry a cross before the corpse, at eight in the morning or two in the afternoon (Sehling 3, p. 261).
- **Neubrandenburg 1559**: see the next quotation.
- **Transylvania 1607**: the synod counts among the superstitions of funerals "that torches and lights are kept burning whole nights by the dead not yet buried" (Sehling 24, p. 494).

Neubrandenburg, *Kirchenordnung* of the visitors, 1559 (Sehling 5, p. 269):

Eighteenthly. When there are dead, there is here a heathenish custom: they keep a night watch, roast the calf, and practise many superstitions, more than can all be named; these shall hereby be wholly abolished. Neither shall any vigil be sung any more in or before the houses; but when the scholars come, the corpse shall be carried straight out to the churchyard, and the cantor with the scholars shall go before and sing by the grave until the body be buried. Thereafter one of the preachers shall make a short exhortation of man's toilsome life and of the joyful resurrection.

Before the house, in Latin. At Pirna the deacons still sang a set of Latin responsories before the house of the dead, and German hymns followed in the churchyard. **Pirna, *Kirchenordnung* of Anton Lauterbach, 1555** (Sehling 1, p. 644):

For the godly that fall asleep in Christ the ringing of the bells shall be permitted, and for the burial one bell shall sound, to call the people together to the funeral; at which one deacon or both, and the pastor also if they be called, standing before the house, shall sing in Latin: "If we have received good things"; "My Redeemer" etc.; "If we believe" etc.; "In the midst of life we are in death"; "Behold, I shew you a great mystery"; "When Jesus was come into the ruler's house" etc. In the churchyard, the people being gathered, German songs shall be sung

The responsory from Job. One piece of the old Matins survived widely: the responsory *Credo quod Redemptor meus vivit* (I believe that my Redeemer liveth). The Braunschweig-Wolfenbüttel order of 1543 has the scholars sing it first of all before the bier, "with the verse and repetition", as a responsory is sung in the office. **Braunschweig-Wolfenbüttel, *Christlike kerken-ordeninge*, 1543** (Sehling 6/1, pp. 67–68):

Burying the dead. The scholars, with one or more of the school's assistants, with the half or with the whole school, according as it is bespoken and paid for, as hath been customary of old, shall go before the bier and sing first in Latin: "My Redeemer liveth" etc., with the verse and the repetition; when that is ended, in German: "Erbarm dich mein, o Herre Gott" (Have mercy on me, O Lord God) etc., "Mitten wir im Leben sind" (In the midst of life we are) etc., "Aus tiefer Not" (Out of deep distress) etc.; by the grave the hymn "Nun lasst uns den Leib begraben" (Now let us bury the body) etc.; or something else.

- The editors identify the piece as the responsory *Credo quod Redemptor meus vivit* of the office of the dead (Sehling 6/1, p. 68).
- Hildesheim's town order of 1544 repeats the passage. Its editors call the piece a "responsory from the office of the dead (after Job 19:25–27)" (Sehling 7/2.1, p. 866).
- It stands also at Pirna (above), and in the Rostock *Conformitas* of about 1560 as *Scio quod redemptor meus* (I know that my redeemer [liveth]; Sehling 5, p. 290).

The canticles of Lauds. The Brandenburg-Nürnberg order of 1533 and the Pfalz-Neuburg order of 1543 sing at the burial the two canticles of the old Lauds of the dead, though they do not say so (the identification is this book's):

- **Brandenburg-Nürnberg 1533** has the scholars sing the *Benedictus* or Psalm 90, with the antiphon *Media vita* (In the midst of life) or *Ego sum resurrectio et vita* (I am the resurrection and the life; Chapter 13, §13.9.3).
- **Pfalz-Neuburg 1543** gives three Latin canticles to choose from at the body: Psalm 90, the canticle of Hezekiah, *Ego dixi: In dimidio dierum meorum* (I said, In the cutting off of my days; Isaiah 38:10–20; the editors print "30"), and the *Benedictus*. They are sung with *Media vita* or *Ego sum resurrectio et vita* (Sehling 13, p. 90).

In the Roman office of the dead the canticle of Hezekiah and the *Benedictus* with *Ego sum resurrectio* (I am the resurrection) both belong to Lauds (§10.9.1).

An office after the burial: Brandenburg 1540. Joachim II's order keeps the most. After the procession the mourners go back into the church for what is in effect a short office of the dead without prayer for the dead. It has lessons from Job, responsories, the *Benedictus* with *Ego sum resurrectio*, a German collect and the responsory *Si bona suscepimus* (If we have received good things). **Brandenburg, *Kirchen-ordnung* of Joachim II, 1540** (Sehling 3, p. 81):

And when they go again from the burial into the church, then may be sung "Mit Fried und Freud ich fahr dahin" (With peace and joy I depart); and thereupon be read one or more lessons out of Job, or out of Paul of the resurrection, and between them some responsories or German songs; thereafter the *Benedictus* with the antiphon *Ego sum resurrectio et vita*, and then a German collect, as followeth […] And for the conclusion the responsory *Si bona suscepimus*; and a basin shall be set in the church for the offering or alms for the poor folk

The rest of the order's burial chapter:

- **The collect** is the Saxon burial collect (Chapter 13, §13.9.2).
- **A Mass may follow.** If the burial was in the morning, a Mass might be held: "the office *Si enim credimus*", with the epistle 1 Thessalonians 4:13 and the gospel John 11:25. These are the epistle and gospel of the requiem on the day of burial in the Roman missal. After an evening burial the Mass was put off to the next day.
- **No communion at it.** Communicants were to commune at the common daily office "and not at this one; for else an abuse would easily arise from it, and in time it be taken again for a soul-Mass".
- **No thirtieth days.** "Much less tolerable are the thirtieth days and anniversaries, with the soul-offering Masses" (Sehling 3, p. 81).

A yearly day of the dead, for the living. The same order keeps one yearly service of the dead, on All Souls' Day and on two Ember Fridays. **Brandenburg, *Kirchen-ordnung* of Joachim II, 1540** (Sehling 3, p. 81):

But that it may be marked that we would gladly keep all that may be turned to the betterment of the church, we are content that yearly a special office, and with it a sermon of the departed, and of mortality and the resurrection of the dead, be held in the foundations and parishes on All Souls' Day, and on the Friday in the Ember weeks of Reminiscere and of Trinity; and that therewith the people be in especial warned to beware of the old abuses […] for since there is no corpse present, and the remembrance of death and resurrection is set forth therein, it can be counted for no *Begängnis* (obsequies) of the departed, but for the good of the living

The service is again the office *Si enim credimus* (For if we believe), and here communicants may receive. No other order in the corpus keeps a service of All Souls' Day:

- **Strasbourg 1542** (Moderate Reformed): some wished to mark All Saints and All Souls at the end of the next Sunday's sermon, "so that the true care for the dead be rightly taught, and the false and superstitious be wholly rooted out". Others wanted the feast deliberated further (Sehling 20/1, p. 326).
- **Hohenlohe 1558** has the preachers explain the day's abuse at that season (Sehling 15, p. 125).
- **Sayn 1582** strikes All Souls' Day with the saints' days (Sehling 19/1, p. 373).

The Reformed. Nassau-Dillenburg's order of 1582 (Reformed) keeps at funerals:

- short exhortations and consolations, "or lessons of a chapter of the Bible, as John 12, 1 Corinthians 15, 1 Thessalonians 4 and 5, Ezekiel 37, Job 19, Psalm 39";
- and it forbids "excessive commendations of the dead, with all superstition" (Sehling 10, p. 163).

Job 19 is the chapter of *Credo quod Redemptor* (I believe that my Redeemer [liveth]).

10.9.6 What took its place

Accompanying the dead. Brenz answered his own history of the vigil (§10.9.1) with three things: the procession to the grave, a mention in the next day's service, and comfort for the kin. **Schwäbisch Hall, *Kirchenordnung*, 1527** (Sehling 17/1, p. 60):

Since then the vigils and Masses, as they are now held, are unprofitable for the dead, how shall one then bear oneself toward them? Shall no regard be had of them at all? In no wise. It is not seemly that one cast them away like carrion, for the departed are still our brethren, and are not fallen out of our fellowship through death. We remain still members of one only body. Therefore the Christian congregation shall be diligently exhorted, not to vigils and soul-Masses as hitherto, but, after the first use of the church, diligently to accompany the departed to the grave, which civil neighbourliness also requireth. He shall also be remembered in the service of the day following, after the departed is buried, and his death shall be announced. Therewith the kinsfolk shall be comforted through the word of God, and the others exhorted to be ready in their faith and hope, and of good courage, to follow the call of God, when and how he will.

The funeral sermon. Wittgenstein put the funeral sermon expressly "instead of the vigils", and paid for it with the old fees. **Wittgenstein, *Kirchenordnung*, 1555** (Sehling 22, p. 87):

And forasmuch as many dues have been given and endowed for unchristian ceremonies and uses, the pastors and ministers of the church shall hereby be discharged once for all from keeping up such idolatrous doings any longer; yet shall they be bound and owe it to do in return something else that serveth to the honour of God and to the edifying and instruction of the parishioners, with the counsel of the superintendent, each one like the other, that it may not be said that the ministers of the church take their dues for nought or in vain and do nothing for them. But in especial, instead of the vigils, the pastors shall make funeral sermons, which they may take from Spangenberg and from his sermons, which he and others have made at burials and which have gone forth in print, and do after them.

The editors identify the book as Johann Spangenberg's fifteen funeral sermons of 1545 (Sehling 22, p. 87).

Hymns and a short sermon. Hohenlohe in 1553 set hymns and a sermon in the place of the soul-Masses, vigils, *Begängnisse* (obsequies) and anniversaries (Sehling 15, p. 80):

- the dead are not to be "carried out and buried like the unreasoning beast";
- they are escorted with *Media vita* (In the midst of life) and *Mit fried und freud ich far dahin* (With peace and joy I depart);
- *Nun last uns den leib begraben* (Now let us bury the body) is sung at the grave;
- the pastor makes, before or after the burial, "a short sermon and exhortation of the resurrection of Christians".

A word at the grave. The visitors at Neubrandenburg (1559) put a short exhortation "of man's toilsome life and of the joyful resurrection" in place of the vigil at the house (above). The funeral sermon and its growth are treated in Chapter 11, §11.4.6.

10.9.7 Summary by order

Order	What it says of the vigil	Sehling
Wittenberg 1522	the vigil priests' income to the common chest; they are to visit the sick	1, p. 697
Coburg 1524 (proposal)	burial, vigil and soul-Mass left to the family	1, p. 543
Mülhausen 1524 (Reformed)	vigils and anniversaries left unchanged for now; Geschmus would have joined the week's vigils	20/2, pp. 163, 197
Pomesania 1524	no ringing, singing, Mass or vigils over the dead	4, p. 29
Nördlingen 1525	vigils and Masses for the dead put away	12, pp. 298, 305
Strasbourg 1525 (Moderate Reformed)	soul-Masses and vigils abolished by the council	20/1, p. 45
Goslar 1525 (the commons)	complaint at the doubled presence money for the vigils	7/2.2, p. 184
Ansbach 1526	old foundations kept until a council	11, p. 94
Schwäbisch Hall 1527	the vigil was the first church's night watch; procession, mention and comfort instead	17/1, p. 60
Lüneburg 1527	vigils, soul-Masses, *Kalande* (Kaland brotherhoods), thirtieth days and anniversaries abolished	6/1, p. 515
Saxony 1528	vigils would make sin removable by works	1, p. 164
Mülhausen 1528 (Reformed)	the vigil's psalms and Job lessons may stay, in Latin	20/2, pp. 209–210
Hamburg 1529	vigils built on 2 Maccabees; their money to the poor chest	5, pp. 520, 533
Heilbronn 1529	the bell for vigils stopped on All Souls' Day	17/1, pp. 225–226
Heilbronn 1530	no help to the dead; the first church's watch	17/1, pp. 278–279
Minden 1530	vigil, memorial and soul-Mass against Scripture	21, p. 144
Goslar, St Simon and Judas, 1534	canons to put away the vigils	7/2.2, p. 264
Pomerania 1535	an abuse of the psalms and of Job for purgatory	4, pp. 342, 350
Freiberg 1537	vigils, anniversaries and thirtieth days abolished	1, p. 466
Lippe 1538	vigils among the false good works	21, p. 312
Northeim 1539	vigils and *Begängnis* (obsequies) abolished	6/2, p. 932
Brandenburg 1540	an office after the burial with Job lessons and *Benedictus*; a yearly service on All Souls' Day	3, p. 81
Calenberg-Göttingen 1542	"a pure abomination"; abolished in the convents; the endowments to the chest	6/2, pp. 760, 852, 858
Frankenberg convent 1542	vigils dropped, the hours kept	7/2.2, p. 275
Perleberg 1542	the pastor compensated for the lost fees	3, p. 245
Schleswig-Holstein 1542	the Pomeranian ruling in Low German	23, p. 144
Wurzen 1542	vigils abolished with the Canon	2, p. 98

Order	What it says of the vigil	Sehling
Strasbourg 1542 (Moderate Reformed)	All Saints and All Souls to be marked at the Sunday sermon, the true care for the dead taught; disputed	20/1, p. 326
Braunschweig-Wolfenbüttel 1543	*Redemptor meus vivit* (my Redeemer liveth) before the bier	6/1, pp. 67–68
Bonnus (Osnabrück chapters) 1543	vigils and prayers for the dead omitted	7/1, p. 229
Pfalz-Neuburg 1543	the canticle of Hezekiah or the *Benedictus* at the burial	13, p. 90
Hildesheim 1544	*Redemptor meus vivit* before the bier	7/2.1, p. 866
Donauwörth 1545	the school freed from singing vigils	12, p. 160
Heidelberg 1546	vigils suspended, the rents kept	14, p. 92
Hohenlohe 1553	hymns and a sermon instead	15, p. 80
Pirna 1555	Latin responsories sung before the house	1, p. 644
Wittgenstein 1555	funeral sermons instead of the vigils	22, p. 87
Palatinate 1556	no more vigils or papal lays	14, p. 112
Prenzlau 1557	the vigils before the door abolished	3, p. 261
Hohenlohe 1558	the abuse of All Souls' Day to be explained	15, p. 125
Neubrandenburg 1559	no vigil in or before the houses	5, p. 269
Rostock c. 1560	*Scio quod redemptor meus* (I know that my redeemer [liveth]) at funerals	5, p. 290
Schaumburg convents 1562	vigils and soul-Masses to cease	7/2.2, pp. 35, 60
Ermsleben 1564	the "vigil" sung at the grave	2, p. 486
Braunschweig-Wolfenbüttel convents 1569	nuns released from vows of psalters for the dead	6/1, p. 334
Mecklenburg convents 1572	the psalter for souls and the *Begängnisse* (obsequies) condemned	5, pp. 253–254
Wolfstein 1574	no vigils to help out of purgatory	13, p. 586
Nassau-Dillenburg 1582 (Reformed)	Bible lessons at funerals, Job 19 among them; no commendations	10, p. 163
Sayn 1582	All Souls' Day abolished	19/1, p. 373
Teschen 1584	soul-Masses, requiem and vigils abolished	3, pp. 462–463
Transylvania 1607	night lights by the unburied dead superstitious	24, p. 494

10.10 The catechism service

A new office. The catechism service (*Katechismus*, *Kinderlehre*, *Kinderpredigt*, *examen catechismi*) had no place in the medieval cursus. The Reformation made it, for the children, the servants and "the simple", and it became the one weekly service besides the Mass and Vespers that nearly every order prescribes. It took three forms:

- **a service of its own**, usually on Sunday at midday or early afternoon, with hymn, prayer, recitation of the text, a short exposition, examination of the young, prayer and blessing (§§10.10.2–10.10.3);
- **a catechism joined to Vespers**, where a boy recited the chief parts, or the catechism was preached in place of the Vespers sermon (§10.10.4);

- **a recitation inside another service**: the text of the catechism read before or after the morning sermon, or at the weekday offices (§10.10.5).

The Reformed orders built a fourth form on the same plan: the catechism divided into Sundays, the youth reciting a fixed portion, and the minister expounding it (§10.10.6). How often the catechism was taught, and what had to be known before first communion, are treated in Chapter 15, §15.11; the catechism sermon as a sermon in Chapter 11, §11.4.3.

10.10.1 Origins: Luther and Wittenberg

A weekday lesson and a Sunday sermon. Luther's *Deutsche Messe* (German Mass) of 1526 set the catechism on weekday mornings: "on Monday and Tuesday early there is a German lesson on the Ten Commandments, on the Creed and Our Father, on baptism and the sacrament, that these two days may keep up the catechism and strengthen it in its right understanding" (Sehling 1, pp. 13–14). By 1533 the Wittenberg town church gave it the first service of Sunday. "On Sunday early a priest or deacon shall preach out of the catechism, and when the catechism is ended, begin it again"; after the sermon "all the words of the catechism" were to be said to the people, with Christ's command concerning both sacraments. A fourth deacon rode out to the villages after the high Mass on holy days to preach the catechism to the peasants, with a German psalm before and after (Sehling 1, pp. 700–701).

10.10.2 When, and how long

The hour. Most orders set the catechism at midday or early afternoon on Sunday, after the morning service and dinner:

- at **twelve**, when the clock had struck (Neckarbischofsheim 1560), or at twelve after an hour of psalm-singing from eleven (Rostock, *Conformitas*, c. 1560);
- at **one** (Mecklenburg 1552; Sangerhausen 1555; Lippe 1571; Oldenburg 1573);
- at **one or two**, "as the occasion of the place may suffer" (Pfalz-Veldenz 1574);
- "straight at midday or at Vespers time" in the Württemberg villages (1553).

Some places put it first in the day instead: at Schwäbisch Hall (1543) it was held at six in summer and seven in winter, before the main service, and Pomerania (1569) allowed "early in the morning or at twelve at midday" (Sehling 4, p. 385). Weekday catechisms were set by the convenience of the work: on Tuesday afternoon at two in winter and Thursday at twelve in summer at Brandis (1574, Sehling 1, p. 534); on Monday at two or three for the public examination at Thorn (1575, Sehling 4, pp. 236, 238).

The length. The orders that set a length give **half an hour** for the exposition or the examination, and **an hour** at most for the whole:

- Hesse (1566, Moderate Reformed): the youth "is questioned and taught in the catechism about half an hour" every Sunday (Sehling 8, p. 252);
- the Palatinate (1601, Reformed): "some questions … expounded for half an hour" (Sehling 14, p. 558);
- Thorn (1575): "half a little hour" of catechism preaching between the hymn and the *Magnificat* at Sunday Vespers (Sehling 4, p. 238);
- Emden (Micron, 1565, Reformed): the children examined "when the minister hath preached half an hour" (Sehling 7/1, p. 606);
- Rostock (c. 1560): the midday sermon on the catechism "shall not last over an hour" (Sehling 5, p. 289);
- Hohenlohe (1596): the whole act, sermon read, examination, summary, hymn, prayer and blessing, "which shall in no wise last over an hour long" (Sehling 15, p. 663).

Veit Dietrich's Nürnberg *Agendbüchlein* (1545) joins a catechism sermon, read from the printed book, to the Litany on the one weekday when the people met, "so that this be ended in about half an hour at the longest, and the people come again to their work" (Sehling 11, p. 504).

The season. Nassau-Dillenburg (1575, Philippist) held the Sunday afternoon *Kinderlehre* (children's teaching) only "from Whitsun until Michaelmas", with a weekday hour through the whole year in the towns (Sehling 10, p. 148). At Obermaßfeld (Henneberg, 1563) the pastor took the Passion history instead of the catechism in Lent, and gave the children questions on the Passion (Sehling 2, p. 343). Limpurg (1610) let the catechism sermon and the children's recitation fall on Easter, Whitsun and a Christmas falling on Sunday (Sehling 16, p. 616).

10.10.3 The order of the Lutheran catechism service

The common shape. The Lutheran orders vary in detail but agree on a shape:

1. a bell, often the small bell;
2. a hymn, usually one of Luther's catechism hymns (the Ten Commandments, *Wir glauben* [We believe], *Vater unser im Himmelreich* [Our Father in the kingdom of heaven], *Christ unser Herr zum Jordan kam* [Christ our Lord came to the Jordan]);
3. the Our Father or a prayer for the understanding of the word;
4. the text of the chief parts, said aloud by the pastor or recited by boys;
5. the exposition of one part, taken in course, "and when it is ended, begin again";
6. the examination of the children, by question and answer;
7. a prayer or collect, often a prayer for the children;
8. a hymn and the blessing.

Mecklenburg, 1552: the North German pattern. The Mecklenburg order put the children's instruction before the sermon and joined both to Vespers canticles. Its paragraph was copied word for word by Oldenburg (1573), and closely by Lüneburg (1564) and Braunschweig-Wolfenbüttel (1569) (Sehling 7/2.1, p. 1095, n. 6). **Mecklenburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1552** (Sehling 5, p. 200):

In the afternoon at one the scholars shall begin to sing a psalm or two; or they sing the Ten Commandments, *Vater unser im Himmelreich*, *Christ unser Herr zum Jordan kam*, and the like. Thereafter let the preacher instruct the children in the catechism; that is, that he question them one after another, and let them say the Ten Commandments to him by heart, item the exposition, which the children shall learn and say off word for word out of the Small Catechism of Dr Martin Luther. Likewise let him another time take another part of the catechism in hand, unto the end; and then shall one begin again from the front. Thereafter let the *Magnificat* be sung. Thereafter the preacher goeth up into the pulpit and speaketh out with a loud voice the Ten Commandments, the Creed, the Our Father, the words of baptism and the words of the Supper. Then he taketh a part of the catechism in hand, to set it forth to the people with diligence and to explain it. At the end of the sermon he exhorteth the people to prayer. After the sermon is sung *Lord, now lettest thou thy servant depart in peace*; thereupon a collect is read, and it is concluded with the *Benedicamus Domino* (Let us bless the Lord).

Neckarbischofsheim, 1560: a full ordo. A small Kraichgau order sets the midday catechism out step by step. **Neckarbischofsheim, *Kirchenordnung*, 1560** (Sehling 16, p. 672):

At midday, after dinner, the catechism and children's teaching is wont to be held, whereat this is sung: *Herre Gott, dein Treu mit Gnaden leist* (Lord God, perform thy faithfulness with grace), or else what serveth thereto. But the order is held thus. First, when it hath struck twelve, a good long sign is rung with the small bell. After that they begin to sing the Our Father, or else a hymn. When that is at an end, the pastor goeth up into the pulpit and explaineth the catechism, taking one chief part after another; when he hath finished it, he beginneth it again. After this, when the sermon is finished, he readeth all six parts of Christian doctrine out of Luther's catechism. When he hath brought it to the end, the boys recite the catechism, yet one part after another, one every Sunday. Afterwards the pastor readeth the next chief part, that followeth after that which the boys have recited. Thereafter he questioneth some among the young folk; after that he concludeth it with a prayer, as it standeth set down in Luther's catechism. Hereupon, when the prayer is ended, the pastor saith: Let us thank God the Lord with the song of praise. Hereupon the schoolmaster, or whoso is in his stead, singeth the last stanza of the hymn *Herr Gott, dein Treu mit Gnaden leist* (Lord God, perform thy faithfulness with grace). Thereafter the pastor stepeth before the altar and giveth the blessing.

Hesse, 1566: two kinds of hearer. The Hessian order (Moderate Reformed) gives the fullest rationale, and divides the exposition between "the children and simple" and those who have grasped the text. **Hesse, *Kirchenordnung*, 1566** (Moderate Reformed; Sehling 8, pp. 251–252):

When now the congregation is come to the catechism, these things are done one after another. First a psalm is sung; next followeth the hymn of the Ten Commandments, of the Creed, of the Lord's Prayer, etc. […] Secondly: after the hymn the minister of the word goeth up into the pulpit and rehearseth one after another, aloud and understandably, the parts of the children's doctrine, as they are gathered together in Luther's catechism. […] When now the sermon of the catechism is ended, and those that are appointed to hear the catechism have sat down, the teacher trieth certain children here and there with questions and answers, requiring of one this part, of another another, to rehearse and to explain. And when he hath gone round the simple, he goeth on to those that are better instructed in the catechism, and requireth of them a full exposition and account. In this wise

every Sunday, and also on the other days appointed thereto in the week, the youth is questioned and taught in the catechism about half an hour [...] Fifthly, after the examination of the catechism a psalm is sung [...] Finally the minister of the word concludeth this action with the blessing of Numbers 6, as is customary, and letteth the assembly go.

Between the recitation and the examination came the sermon, divided into two parts: first "with short and understandable words" for the children and simple, then "with proofs of the sayings of holy Scripture" for those who had the text already (Sehling 8, pp. 251–252). Where the people met only once on Sunday afternoon, Hesse (Moderate Reformed) folded the catechism into the afternoon service: psalm, epistle, its exposition, the catechism read, one part expounded, the children questioned, a psalm and the blessing (Sehling 8, p. 253).

Württemberg, 1553: exposition, hearing, prayer. The Württemberg order is briefer. It asks each pastor or deacon to set "a special time" on Sunday for the catechism, chiefly for the young. **Württemberg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1553** (Sehling 16, p. 243):

the pastor or his deacon shall first explain and expound one point or article of the following catechism after another, briefly and understandably, that the young may not only grow used to the words, but also come by a good, Christian understanding of the same. After that he shall hear certain of the young openly, that thereby not only the aptness of the same young ones be learned, but also the others may learn the catechism from them. And the ministers of the church shall deal with the youth so friendly and graciously that they be not frighted away from the catechism, but made glad thereto.

The service closed with a set prayer, "after the explanation or exposition of the catechism and the children have been heard", for the children whom God "hast given to thy church and born again through holy baptism", that he would "strengthen this thy work which thou hast begun in them" (Sehling 16, p. 246).

The village catechism: Lippe, 1571. In the villages, where there was no afternoon sermon, the catechism service was the pastor's and the sexton's alone. **Lippe, *Kirchenordnung*, 1571** (Sehling 21, p. 397):

Since in the villages no afternoon sermon can be held, for many causes, the pastors shall nevertheless, together with the sexton, call together by a ringing of the bell, about one o'clock, all simple, unlearned country folk, be they young or old, boys or maidens; and when the same are assembled [...] a German psalm shall be taken out of the spiritual songs, in which each part of the catechism is briefly and roundly composed, and sung slowly with the children. Thereupon the pastor shall read the five chief parts of the Christian religion, which are called the catechism, with clear, understandable words, and thereafter explain one part at each time, quite briefly and simply, by question and answer.

Oldenburg (1573) took over the Lippe text (Sehling 7/2.1, p. 1113), and Pfalz-Veldenz (1574) has the same order: "short hymn and prayer", the examination with the recitation of the parts, a German psalm, then the sermon with "question and answer" and the closing prayer, hymn and blessing (Sehling 18, p. 523).

Nördlingen, 1544: recitation by two boys. In the Swabian towns the recitation was given to the schoolboys. **Nördlingen, *Ordnung der ceremonien in der pfarkirchen zu Sant Georgen*, 1544** (Sehling 12, p. 319):

At midday, when the catechism is preached which Dr Martin wrote for the simple. 1. First is sung that one of the parts of the catechism whereof the sermon is, as Dr Luther made them. 2. Thereafter two boys recite by heart with clear voice the chief articles of the catechism, after the text only; then that part alone with the exposition, whereof the sermon goeth. 3. Thereupon the people sing *Nun bitten wir* (Now pray we), two stanzas or all four, and the sermon followeth straightway. 4. After the sermon a short psalm according to the season, as above at the high office. 5. Last of all one of the deacons concludeth with the customary versicle and collect and the blessing.

Ysenburg-Birstein, 1588. A Wetterau order gives the same shape with the hymn chosen to fit the part: "when one preacheth the Ten Commandments, then sing the Ten Commandments, and so forth". The pastor recited the five chief parts from the pulpit, expounded one, closed the sermon with prayer, "and then hold the examination with the youth", ending with hymn, prayer "for the preservation of God's word" and blessing (Sehling 10, p. 627).

10.10.4 The catechism in Vespers

The boy's recitation. In Saxony and Thuringia the catechism was often built into Sunday Vespers. A boy recited the chief parts between the lesson and the hymn before the sermon, and the Vespers sermon itself might be on the catechism. **Naumburg, *Kirchen-Ordnung für die St. Wenzelskirche*, 1537** (Sehling 2, p. 72):

At Vespers. 1. First is sung the *Te Deum laudamus* (We praise thee, O God) in German, or else a hymn or psalm according to the season. 2. Thereafter two boys read the chapter out of the epistles of Paul, one in German, the other in Latin. 3. Then a boy reciteth by heart the five chief parts of the catechism. 4. Thereupon is sung *Nun bitten wir den Heiligen Geist* (Now pray we the Holy Ghost), two stanzas. 5. Thereupon followeth the sermon: one year about the other, the one year Luther's Small Catechism, the other the Sunday epistles. 6. The *Magnificat* with its antiphon, *Christus unser Heiland* (Christ our Saviour), or else a short hymn according to the season [...] 7. Thereafter it is concluded with the collect and *Benedicamus*.

Vespers with an examination. Sangerhausen in 1555 added the examination at the altar, after the sermon. **Sangerhausen, *Verordnung der Visitatoren*, 1555** (Sehling 1, p. 658):

In the afternoon at Vespers, at one o'clock, the catechism is preached with hymns as followeth. First a Latin psalm is sung with the boys, together with an antiphon out of the Sunday gospel. 2. A Latin responsory or hymn *de tempore* (of the season). 3. Thereupon a German hymn, that the people may help. 4. A German lesson out of the Old or New Testament, which a boy readeth. 5. Thereupon a German song is sung with the people, commonly of the part of the catechism whereof the sermon is; or the German *Magnificat*. 6. The sermon of the catechism followeth, after Luther's order [...] 7. After the sermon a church hymn is sung, as *Erhalt uns, Herr, bei deinem Wort* (Keep us, Lord, by thy word), or *Gott der Vater wohn uns bei* (God the Father, dwell with us). 8. Meanwhile the young folk gather at the altar, and the pastor questioneth them in turn out of the catechism, Luther's short exposition, taking two commandments each time, and so forth, until he bring it to the end. 9. It is concluded with the hymn *Verleih uns Frieden gnädiglich* (Grant us peace graciously), together with the collect belonging thereto.

Other Vespers forms.

- **Regensburg 1553**: at Sunday Vespers the hymn was left out "for the sake of the long catechism", and a piece of the Nürnberg catechism was read from the pulpit, the choir closing with a German psalm suited to it (Sehling 13, p. 421).
- **Sulzfeld 1566**: German psalm and hymn; two boys recite a piece of the catechism "with the exposition"; the German *Te Deum* (We praise thee, O God); then the pastor recites "word for word" the chief parts, the morning and evening blessing and the graces, questions the young, and expounds the next part; German *Magnificat*, collect, *Benedicamus* (Sehling 2, p. 353).
- **Gottleuba 1567**: after the lesson "two boys recite a piece of the holy catechism, and always add the questions on the holy sacrament", before the *Magnificat*; on ordinary Sundays the Vespers sermon was on the catechism (Sehling 1, p. 568).
- **Penig 1575**: after the Vespers *Magnificat* the deacon reads the "table of the six chief parts" or some questions, then expounds one part, so that the catechism is finished each year by Advent; after the sermon the school children, boys and girls on alternate Sundays, say a part with Luther's exposition (Sehling 1, p. 634).
- **Albertine Saxony 1580**: "when Vespers is ended, let a piece of the catechism be taken in hand and expounded to the people in the simplest wise" (Sehling 1, p. 369).
- **Solms-Laubach 1603**: at Saturday and feast-eve Vespers "a boy recites a chief part of the catechism", before the *Magnificat* (Sehling 9, p. 357).

Thorn, 1575: the catechism through the week. The Prussian city of Thorn put the catechism into every daily office. At German Matins on weekdays "a boy readeth the *capita catechismi* plainly, and straight thereafter one *caput catechismi* with the exposition" (Sehling 4, p. 238), and the same at weekday Vespers (p. 239), so that "the *capita catechismi* with Luther's exposition shall be read through and repeated weekly" (p. 239). On Sunday and Monday the catechism had services of its own. **Thorn, *Kirchenordnung*, 1575** (Sehling 4, p. 238):

On Sunday in the Old Town at St John's, as also in the New Town parish church, Latin Vespers is sung; between the hymn and the *Magnificat* half a little hour is preached on the catechism, and Vespers concluded with a collect. On Monday the German Vespers in the cloister is left off, and instead the examination of the catechism is held at two o'clock at St John's.

The same order put the Sunday catechism sermon into both German and Polish, "about half a little hour", and the Monday examination at St John's ran through the catechism "in six weeks", one part each Monday, "and begun again" (Sehling 4, p. 236).

10.10.5 The catechism in the morning service

The text before the gospel or after the sermon. Many orders had the bare text of the catechism said in the morning service, so that the whole congregation heard it every Sunday:

- **Strasbourg 1548** (Moderate Reformed; an agreement of the clergy on the Interim): after the morning sermon, which was not to run "beyond a third of an hour" at the cathedral and half an hour elsewhere, "the recitation of the six *loci* of the catechism ought to follow the exposition of the gospel"; at the cathedral the first three one Sunday, the other three the next (Sehling 20/1, p. 355).
- **Albertine Saxony 1580**: the visitors asked whether the pastor "speak the catechism to the people on Sundays and holy days before the gospel is read" (Sehling 1, p. 393).
- **Pomerania 1569**: in the villages the sexton is to read a piece of the catechism "after the epistle", and the pastor to preach the catechism in the afternoon (Sehling 4, p. 384).
- **Nördlingen 1579**: on Sundays and holy days, after the epistle and its hymn, "a piece of Luther's catechism is read in order, and when it is ended, it shall be begun again", before the German Creed (Sehling 12, p. 375).
- **The Palatinate 1563** (Reformed): the minister read a portion of the catechism before every Sunday and feast-day sermon, "so that it be read through in nine Sundays" (Sehling 14, p. 342).

An early catechism service: Schwäbisch Hall, 1543. Brenz's Hall had the catechism as the first service on Sunday, before the main service, on alternate Sundays examined and preached. On the examination Sundays it borrowed the opening of the Mass. **Schwäbisch Hall, *Kirchenordnung*, 1543** (Sehling 17/1, pp. 162–163):

On Sunday early in the morning, in summer at six o'clock and in winter at seven o'clock, the catechism […] shall be held in the parish church of St Michael with the following order: namely, that the questions be heard from the children on the one Sunday, and on the other Sunday be preached and expounded in order one after another. And when the questions are heard from the children, the Kyrie eleison shall first be sung, together with the German *Glory be to God on high*, etc. Thereupon the catechist, after the prayer going before, shall recite the text of the gospel that falleth on the same Sunday, and teach out of it a common place for the youth. After that the children shall be set up in order, pair by pair, each to ask the other the questions in the [catechism] openly […] Thereupon shall be sung the Ten Commandments in German, or another spiritual hymn of thanks or praise according to the season, and after that a prayer for the children shall be said.

The prayer for the children recalls the angels set over children and Christ's "Suffer the children to come unto me", and the blessing follows. On the preaching Sundays the schoolboys sang the Latin introit, Kyrie and *Gloria in excelsis*, and the catechist expounded the gospel briefly and then "a question in the catechism, … until he have preached out the whole catechism" (Sehling 17/1, p. 163).

A printed catechism sermon. The Brandenburg-Nürnberg order of 1533 printed a set of *Kinderpredigten* for pastors to read, each beginning with a "common beginning to all sermons", a greeting and the bidding: "to speak and to learn something profitable of the word of God, desire grace and say an Our Father!" (Sehling 11, p. 206). Dietrich's *Agendbüchlein* (agenda booklet) and the Hohenlohe order of 1596 have the catechism sermon "read" from the printed book, not preached (Sehling 11, p. 504; 15, p. 663).

10.10.6 The Reformed catechism service

Divided by Sundays. The Reformed Heidelberg Catechism of 1563 was printed in Sunday divisions so that it could be recited and expounded in a year. Its order sets the afternoon service. **Palatinate, *Kirchenordnung*, 1563** (Reformed; Sehling 14, p. 342):

Further, every Sunday afternoon, at the hour that is convenient for each place, the catechism sermon shall be held thus: that the minister of the church first, after the hymn, pray the Our Father and call upon God for the right understanding of his word, and thereafter read the Ten Commandments understandably to the people. Thereupon he shall hear the beginners, who cannot yet learn the questions that are preached, and lead them in order, first for a time to the texts, and thereafter by little and little to the questions also. After this let him have certain among the youth say off a set number of questions in the catechism (as we have for this cause had the same divided into Sundays), which have been explained in the foregoing and especially in the last sermon, and which they have learned beforehand in the school or at home. And when these have thus been said off by some in the presence of the congregation, the minister shall explain and expound certain following questions simply and briefly, so that he preach out the catechism at the least once every year.

The Palatine order of 1601 (Reformed) kept this plan but timed it: in the towns, a first afternoon service with prayer, the summary and the texts of the five chief parts, "some questions … expounded for half an hour", the examination and blessing; and a second towards evening for "the old and grown", more fully. In the villages the youth were examined "when the second bell hath been rung", and the third bell then called the whole congregation to the half-hour sermon (Sehling 14, p. 558).

Classes and the doors shut: Hanau, 1609. The Hanau order of catechisation (Reformed) divided the young into five classes, boys from six to sixteen and girls under fourteen: the Our Father, the Creed, the Ten Commandments, all five chief parts, and the five parts with the added questions and the graces at table and the morning and evening prayers (Sehling 10, p. 487). In the villages the pastor began "with the customary prayer and hymn", read the five chief parts and the questions from the pulpit, and gave a short exposition. Then "pastor, schoolmaster and bell-ringer" heard the classes. After a closing prayer the congregation and children went home, but those summoned stayed behind, men and women, sons and daughters each in their place, "and the church doors also shut", and the pastor read the questions to them "slowly, clearly and distinctly", they repeating "quietly", until they knew them (Sehling 10, p. 491).

Emden: the great catechism and the examination of the little ones. In Micron's order (Reformed) the Sunday catechism sermon on the great catechism was interrupted for the examination of the young children twice a year. **Emden, Micron's *Ordinancien*, German edition, 1565** (Reformed; Sehling 7/1, p. 606):

And this examination is held always on the Sunday, openly, at the time of the explanation of the great catechism, when the minister hath preached half an hour. When all these questions and answers are done, and the minister hath made an exhortation to the parents of the same, that they so continue to bring up their children in the fear of the Lord, then the minister exhorteth the whole congregation to thanksgiving, and prayeth thus.

The thanksgiving begins "O gracious Father, who out of the mouth of young children and sucklings preparest thy praise", and asks that God "would so strengthen and govern these our children with thy Holy Spirit" that they walk "in the ways of truth" (Sehling 7/1, p. 606).

10.10.7 The ordo compared

Key. H = hymn; P = prayer or Our Father; T = text of the chief parts said or read; R = recitation by children; X = exposition or sermon; E = examination; C = collect or closing prayer; B = blessing; V = set within Vespers.

Order	Vol., p.	Time	Ordo	Length
Wittenberg town, 1533	1, pp. 700–701	Sunday early	X, T, exhortation to prayer	—
Naumburg, St Wenzel, 1537	2, p. 72	Sunday Vespers (V)	*Te Deum* (We praise thee, O God), epistle, R, H, X (alternate years), *Magnificat*, C, *Benedicamus*	—
Schwäbisch Hall, 1543	17/1, pp. 162–163	Sunday 6 or 7 a.m.	Kyrie and Gloria, P, gospel and common place, E (pairs), H, prayer for children, B; alternate Sundays X	—
Nördlingen, 1544	12, p. 319	Sunday midday	H, R (text, then with exposition), H, X, H, C, B	—
Mecklenburg, 1552 (Lüneburg 1564; Braunschweig-Wolfenbüttel 1569; Oldenburg 1573)	5, p. 200	Sunday 1 p.m.	H, E, *Magnificat*, T, X, *Nunc dimittis*, C, *Benedicamus*	—
Württemberg, 1553	16, pp. 243, 246	Sunday, set locally	X, E, prayer for the children	—
Sangerhausen, 1555	1, p. 658	Sunday 1 p.m. (V)	Latin psalm, responsory, H, lesson, H, X, H, E at the altar, *Verleih uns Frieden* (Grant us peace), C	—
Neckarbischofsheim, 1560	16, p. 672	Sunday 12 noon	bell, H, X, T, R, T (next part), E, P, H, B	—

Order	Vol., p.	Time	Ordo	Length
Rostock, *Conformitas*, c. 1560	5, p. 289	Sunday 12 noon	psalms from 11; X; P; psalm	X ≤ 1 hour
Palatinate, 1563 (Reformed)	14, p. 342	Sunday afternoon	H, P, T (Decalogue), beginners heard, R (Sunday portion), X	catechism yearly
Emden (Micron), 1565 (Reformed)	7/1, p. 606	Sunday	X (great catechism), E of little children twice a year, exhortation, thanksgiving	X ½ hour
Hesse, 1566 (Moderate Reformed)	8, pp. 251–253	Sunday afternoon	psalm, catechism hymn, T, X (two parts), E, psalm, B	E about ½ hour
Sulzfeld, 1566	2, p. 353	Sunday Vespers (V)	psalm, H, R, *Te Deum*, T, E, X, *Magnificat*, C, *Benedicamus*	—
Lippe, 1571 (Oldenburg 1573)	21, p. 397	Sunday 1 p.m., villages	bell, catechism hymn, T, X by question and answer, E	—
Pfalz-Veldenz, 1574	18, p. 523	Sunday 1 or 2 p.m.	H, P, E with R, psalm, T, X, P, H, B	—
Thorn, 1575	4, pp. 236–239	Sunday Vespers (V); Monday 2 or 3 p.m.	X between hymn and *Magnificat*; Monday E; daily T and X at Matins and Vespers	X about ½ hour
Penig, 1575	1, p. 634	Sunday Vespers (V)	*Magnificat*, T, X, R, H, C, B	catechism by Advent
Ysenburg-Birstein, 1588	10, p. 627	Sunday afternoon	H, catechism hymn, T, X, P, E, H, P, B	—
Hohenlohe, 1596	15, p. 663	Sunday	H, P, T, X read, E, summary, H, P, B	whole ≤ 1 hour
Palatinate, 1601 (Reformed)	14, p. 558	Sunday afternoon; villages at the 2nd bell	H, P, T, X, E, P, B	X ½ hour
Solms-Laubach, 1603	9, p. 357	Saturday Vespers (V)	psalm, R, *Magnificat*, P, *Benedicamus*	—
Hanau, 1609 (Reformed)	10, pp. 487, 491	Sunday, villages	P, H, T, X, E in five classes, P; adults kept back	—

10.11 The music

10.11.1 The old chant kept

"Out of the former choir books." The chapters kept their medieval chant books. Brandenburg 1540 orders the office sung "according to each bishopric's Breviary, out of the former choir books" (§10.4.2). Verden cathedral in 1606 still sings Vespers "as the old order bringeth with it" (Sehling 7/1, p. 153). The convents kept their Breviaries, corrected (Spandau 1541; Lüneburg 1555, §10.4.4). The Keppel order of 1570 refers its nuns to "their Breviary" for the feasts.

The old tones. The orders also keep the old reciting tones:

- **Pfalz-Neuburg 1543**: even when the nuns psalm in German, they are to do it "in the customary tone, as they are wont in Latin" (§10.8.2).
- **Bugenhagen**: the lessons are sung "with such a tone as one is wont to read lessons at Matins", with the cadence of the old prophecy tone, "*sol sol sol la sol fa fa*" (Sehling 6/1, p. 400; Sehling 4, p. 349).
- **Wittenberg 1533**: the boys end each lesson "as one was wont to read or sing the prophecies, *sol sol mi fa sol sol*" (Sehling 1, p. 703; see Chapter 4, §4.5.1).
- **Prussia 1568**: the Latin lesson is read "in the usual tone", the German one "without tone" (§10.6.1).

10.11.2 The new chant books: Spangenberg and Lossius

The Lutheran antiphoners. From the 1540s the old office chant reached Lutheran schools and churches in two printed Lutheran collections:

- Johann Spangenberg's *Cantiones ecclesiasticae latinae … Kirchengesenge Deudsch* (Latin church songs … German church songs; Magdeburg 1545);
- Lucas Lossius's *Psalmodia, hoc est, cantica sacra veteris ecclesiae selecta* (Psalmody, that is, sacred songs chosen from the ancient church; Nürnberg 1553, with a preface by Melanchthon; second edition Wittenberg 1561).

Both preserved the medieval antiphons, responsories, hymns and psalm tones, purged of what was *de sanctis* (of the saints). Several orders require them by name. **Mecklenburg, *Conformitas ceremoniarum*, c. 1560** (Sehling 5, p. 288):

It is deemed good and held necessary that Lucas Lossius's *Psalmodia* be kept in all churches, and that the choir order itself thereafter.

Oldenburg 1573 wants "a right, pure cantional" in every church and school: "that of the old Master Johann Spangenberg or of Lucas Lossius, together with the German hymnbook of Dr Martin Luther". The organist alternates with the choir in the responsory, hymn and *Magnificat*. **Oldenburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1573** (Sehling 7/2.1, p. 1085):

Where there are organs, the organist shall play a motet after the psalms, whereupon the lesson is read; after which the organist shall begin to play the responsory or hymn, as the schoolmaster and organist shall always agree with one another thereon; and then in the *Magnificat* play and sing one verse after the other. To this end it is needful that in all churches and schools a right, pure cantional be always at hand, namely that of the old Master Johann Spangenberg or of Lucas Lossius, together with the German hymnbook of Dr Martin Luther.

Lohr, 1588. First Vespers of Sundays and feasts are sung in Latin, "according to the order of Lossius's *Psalmodia*, as they are noted for every occasion". **Rieneck, *Vesperordnung zu Lohr*, 1588** (Sehling 11, p. 699):

(that the youth be exercised in psalmody and plainchant, as is customary in all churches) [it shall] be sung and kept with Latin psalms, responsories, hymns, *Magnificat*, collects, versicles, *Benedicamus* and the rest, according to the order of L. Lossius's *Psalmodia*, as the same are noted for every occasion and have hitherto been in use and practice

Other orders cite Lossius too:

- **Hof 1592** cites antiphons "in Lossius's *Psalmodia*" and "in the great thin antiphoner" (Sehling 11, p. 422).
- **Lüneburg 1575** refers to "Lossius's book" for the festal Compline (Sehling 6/1, p. 658).
- **Buxtehude 1565** takes its noted pieces from Lossius's second edition (Sehling 7/1, p. 67, introduction).

10.11.3 German psalm tones

Keppel, 1570. The German office at Keppel is sung from the printed German psalm-books with their notes. The preacher is to teach the nuns the melodies. **Nassau-Dillenburg, *Ordnung für das Kloster Keppel*, 1570** (Sehling 10, p. 133):

The two choirs also shall sing one verse after the other, and change the tones, as the same are written down with their notes and melodies in […] the German psalm-books that have come out at Leipzig; herein shall the preacher instruct them, that they may learn the melodies and notes.

Sehling's editor identifies the book as probably Luther's hymnbook printed by Valentin Babst at Leipzig in 1545 (Sehling 10, p. 133, n. 13). Here the old psalm tones carry the German psalter.

German canticles. Luther's own German versions of the office canticles came into use beside the Latin:

- the German *Te Deum* (We praise thee, O God; "Herr Gott, dich loben wir"), sung at Wittenberg 1533 in alternation between the choir and the people (Sehling 1, p. 705);
- the German *Magnificat*, sung at Hof 1592 "in the sixth tone" (below).

10.11.4 Figural music and the organ

Polyphony at the office.

- **Wittenberg 1533**: "when the cantors sing *in figurativis*" at Vespers, they sing everything with the *Magnificat* before the sermon, and on Sundays "after the *Benedicamus* let the boys sing the *Nunc dimittis in figurativis* or in counterpoint" (Sehling 1, pp. 703, 705).
- **Württemberg cloister schools, 1582 edition**: the singing is to be "directed to counterpoint, whereby it is so much the lovelier and more understandable" (Sehling 16, p. 366, apparatus).
- **Hof 1592**: Vespers may be sung *figuraliter* (in figured music). Its Saturday Vespers has the German *Magnificat* in the sixth tone, with boys and girls in alternation and the organ between. **Hof, *Ordo ecclesiasticus*, 1592** (Sehling 11, p. 429):

The German *Magnificat* of the sixth tone is sung by two choirs, the scholars being divided, namely one verse by the boys, the other by the girls, the melody being always first played by the organist, and every third verse being omitted. If the organ is not used, the whole *Magnificat* is completed by the said choirs. […] If the Vesper service is performed figurally, [then] I. the psalm, II. the antiphon, III. the responsory, IIII. one or another verse of the hymn, V. a motet before the sermon, [and] VI. the *Magnificat* in a set tone are sung under the direction of the cantor.

Hof's order notes that the plainchant pieces are written out for every Sunday and feast so that they can be used "when, perhaps because of public mourning, the songs of figural music have no place" (Sehling 11, p. 450).

The organ. The organ alternated with the choir in the office, as in the Mass:

- **Prussia 1568**: the organist "playeth one verse after the other" in the *Magnificat*, and a piece after the *Nunc dimittis* (Sehling 4, p. 75).
- **Pomerania 1569**: "where there are organs, the organist shall be at the organ after the psalmody, and play to the responsory, hymn and *Magnificat*" (Sehling 4, p. 435).
- **Oldenburg 1573** (above) and **Hoya 1581**: the organist "plays the hymn" (§10.7.4).
- **Wittenberg castle, 1525**: the organ only "on Sunday to the *Te Deum laudamus*, and whenever German songs are sung" (Sehling 1, p. 699).

In sum. The medieval office chant was neither abandoned nor wholly reset. In the chapters and convents it went on from the old books. In the schools and towns it was purged and reprinted in the Lutheran antiphoners of Spangenberg and Lossius. Beside it stood:

- Luther's German canticles and hymns;
- German psalms sung to the old tones;
- by the later century, polyphony and organ alternation on Sundays and feasts.

The organ in the service as a whole is treated in Chapter 9, §9.3.

10.12 Ceremonial in the offices and the catechism service

Several matters touching the body are treated elsewhere:

- the short *preces* said kneeling after the gospel canticle: §10.7.5 above;
- the chant, the psalm tones and the lesson tones: §§10.11.1–10.11.3 above;
- the cope and the surplice: Chapter 14, §§14.7.2, 14.7.4;
- lights on the altar: Chapter 14, §14.5.4;
- gestures at the Mass: Chapter 2, §2.15.

This section gathers what the orders prescribe for the body at Matins, Vespers, the Litany and the catechism service.

10.12.1 What the orders say, and what they do not

The searches. The corpus was searched, near the words for the offices (*Mette*, *Vesper*, *horae*, *Complet*, *Benedictus*, *Magnificat*, *Litanei*, *Catechismus*, *Kinderlehre*), for the same families of gesture as at the Mass (Chapter 2, §2.15.1): kneeling and *flexis genibus* (on bended knees); bowing; standing and sitting; hats and bare heads; the hands; turning toward the altar or the people; the sign of the cross; the kiss; incense.

What the orders prescribe. The rubrics for the offices are fewer even than for the Mass. Where the orders say anything, it is one of five things:

- **kneeling to pray**: for the *preces*, the closing collects, the *Da pacem* (Give peace) and the *Veni sancte Spiritus* (Come, Holy Spirit; §10.12.2);
- **kneeling before the altar for the Litany**: two, three or four boys, the choir and the people answering (§10.12.3);
- **two choirs facing**: the psalms sung or said "verse about verse" from stalls set opposite (§10.12.5);
- **the place of the reader**: the pulpit, the lectern, or before the altar (§10.12.6);
- **the children set in order** for the catechism: in pairs facing one another, standing on stools or in the middle of the church, boys on the men's side and girls on the women's (§10.12.7).

Not found. No order in the corpus prescribes any of the following for the office:

- a bow at the *Gloria Patri*, at the name of Jesus, or at the *Gloria* of the hymn. The Mecklenburg convents repeat "Glory be to God the Father" after every psalm and canticle, but say nothing of the head (§10.12.5);
- standing for the gospel canticles, or the sign of the cross at the *Benedictus*, *Magnificat* or *Nunc dimittis*;
- the officiant's hat or biretta, or a rule for covering and uncovering the head in choir;
- incense at the *Magnificat* or *Benedictus*, or the censing of the altar at Vespers;
- genuflection, the hands joined or raised, or a turn toward the people at *Dominus vobiscum* (The Lord be with you) in the office.

The sign of the cross appears only at the household morning and evening blessings (§10.12.8).

10.12.2 Kneeling to pray

After the gospel canticle. The Bugenhagen orders have the children kneel for the short *preces* after the *Magnificat* and *Benedictus* (§10.7.5). **Bremen, *Kirchenordnung*, 1534** (Sehling 7/2.2, p. 463), at the evening office in Our Lady's church:

After the sermon the schoolmaster shall begin the *Magnificat*, thereafter *Da pacem Domine* (Give peace, O Lord) or *Veni Sancte Spiritus* (Come, Holy Spirit). After the antiphon let the children fall upon their knees and say: *Kyrie eleison, Christe eleison, Kyrie eleison. Pater noster.*

At the opening and the close of Vespers. The Pomeranian *Agenda* has the school kneel twice at the Saturday and eve Vespers: for the opening invocation of the Spirit, and for the *Da pacem* (Give peace) after the *Benedicamus*. **Pomerania, *Agenda*, 1569** (Sehling 4, p. 435):

First they sing on bended knees: *Veni sancte Spiritus* (Come, Holy Spirit); or the first verse, *Veni creator Spiritus* (Come, Creator Spirit); or *Adesto Deus unus* (Be present, O one God), etc., or whatsoever else is meet for the season [...] Thereafter the priest readeth a collect in German or Latin, and the choir concludeth with the *Benedicamus*, and singeth thereupon *Da pacem Domine* on bended knees, in Latin or in German.

The other kneeling places.

- **Schönburg 1542, Matins.** After the *Te Deum* (We praise thee, O God) or canticle the boys say "flexis genibus" (on bended knees) the prayers against the Turk, *Da pacem*, and the *preces pro serenitate* (prayers for fair weather) or *pro pluvia* (for rain), with a versicle and collect (Sehling 2, p. 170).
- **Regensburg 1567, Vespers.** After the deacon's German collect, "certain boys, kneeling before the altar", sing the *Benedicamus Domino* (Let us bless the Lord), and the choir answers *Deo gratias* (Sehling 13, p. 461).
- **Stolberg-Königstein 1552, the morning lesson.** After the German psalms the preacher shall "with devotion and wholly kneeling" sing or read three German collects: for forgiveness, for wisdom in government, and for peace (Sehling 9, p. 468).

The Reformed morning and evening prayer. The Palatinate order of 1563 (Reformed) bids the congregation kneel at the opening of its daily prayers. **Palatinate, *Kirchenordnung*, 1563** (Reformed; Sehling 14, p. 396), the morning prayer:

Beloved in the Lord Jesus Christ, let us kneel down before the face of God, and call upon him from the ground of our hearts on this wise.

The evening prayer opens in the same words (Sehling 14, p. 397). The Palatinate order of 1601 (Reformed) reprints both prayers but changes "kneel down" to "humble ourselves" (Sehling 14, p. 572, nn. 12, 15). In East Frisia the editor's note on the Lütetsburg order of 1606 (Reformed) quotes its morning prayer in Low German: "let us kneel down before the face of God" (Sehling 7/1, p. 541).

10.12.3 The Litany: boys kneeling before the altar

The Litany was the one office the orders regularly order to be sung kneeling. The visitors in Mecklenburg wanted the people on their knees for it after the Sunday sermon. **Mecklenburg, *Verordnung der Visitatoren*, 1542** (Sehling 5, p. 149):

Thirdly, the pastor shall on Sunday after the sermon, in towns and villages, devoutly sing the Litany before the people from the pulpit, and the scholars or the sexton, together with the people, shall kneel down and answer him.

The usual form is a small group of boys kneeling before the altar, with the choir and the people answering. **Schwarzburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1574** (Sehling 2, p. 134), on the weekday preaching days:

On one of these days in the week, when the sermon is ended, they are wont to sing the Litany, that is, the common prayer for all manner of need and for all estates of the whole of Christendom. Three boys, clad in white surplices, kneel before the altar and sing the first choir. The schoolboys and the common assembly answer and sing the second choir.

The same arrangement appears elsewhere:

- **Cologne, the prayer-day order of 1546** (Moderate Reformed): three or four boys "kneeling before an altar" begin the Litany, and the whole choir with the pastor, chaplains and priests answers (Sehling 22, p. 45).
- **Waldeck 1556**: "some of the scholars or the pastor, kneeling down before the altar" (Sehling 9, p. 277).
- **Marggrabowa 1581**: every Friday, "two or three boys kneel before the altar", Luther's Litany "and not in rhyme" (Sehling 4, p. 149).
- **Isny c. 1600**: the minister bids, "Let us kneel and so speak and pray together the Christian litany of the Christian church" (Sehling 17/1, p. 468).

The forms of the Litany and who sang it are treated in Chapter 13, §13.21.3.

10.12.4 Kneeling at the evening bell

Kneeling was not confined to the church. During the plague of 1585 the Breslau council asked the people to pray at the evening bell as the morning congregation already did in church. **Breslau, notice of the council concerning the plague, 1585** (Sehling 3, p. 405):

Firstly, forasmuch as in this perilous time a good part of the people hath ever shown itself of a morning at the church prayer and lesson, that they would likewise in the evening, when the bell is rung *pro pace* (for peace), at which time the labourers are wont to go from their work, in turn pray an evening prayer and a little hymn in the house; and those that are going in the street, that they would pray kneeling.

The evening bell itself, and the prayer for peace that replaced the Ave Maria, are treated in Chapter 9, §9.5.3.

10.12.5 Two choirs facing

The psalms were sung by two sides of the choir, verse about verse. Only the Mecklenburg convent order says how the singers stand. **Mecklenburg, *Klosterordnung*, 1572** (Sehling 5, p. 258), for the nuns' Matins:

Thereafter follow the psalms which are appointed for every day in the calendar set before, which the maidens, each in her stall, over against one another, shall pray or sing one verse about the other; and at the end of every psalm, and likewise of the

canticles (*Benedictus*, *Magnificat*, *Benedicite* [Bless ye], *Nunc dimittis*), they shall repeat the verse: Glory be to God the Father and to the Son and to the Holy Ghost.

The same two sides served for the catechism. **Wittenberg, *Kirchen-Ordnung für die Stadt Wittenberg*, 1533** (Sehling 1, p. 703):

Before the early sermon on Sundays or feast days the boys shall read the whole catechism through in Latin in the choir, on both sides, verse about verse, *sine tono* (without tone), distinctly.

10.12.6 The place of the lesson

The orders name the place from which the office lesson is read, but not the reader's posture:

- **Coburg 1545**: at Vespers the chapter of the Old Testament is read in German by the priest "in the pulpit or at the middle altar, according as many or few people are present". On weekdays the epistle and gospel are read "from the altar on a lectern" (Sehling 1, p. 543).
- **Herpf 1566**: at the Saturday evening prayer the chapter is read "before the altar" (Sehling 2, p. 334).
- **Schweinfurt 1543**: one boy, or two or three if the chapter is long, read the Latin lesson; the chaplain then reads it in German "toward the people" (Sehling 11, p. 631).
- **Wittenberg 1533**: three boys read three lessons at Saturday Vespers "after the tone in which lessons are wont to be read", the last words sung (Sehling 1, p. 703).

10.12.7 The catechism service: the children set in order

The catechism service has more stage directions than any office. Five things recur: the minister goes to the altar; the children come out from their places; they are set in pairs facing one another; they stand up, sometimes on stools, to recite; and boys and girls are kept apart.

Facing pairs. The earliest full direction is Schönburg's weekday catechism. **Schönburg lordships, church order of Johann Pfeffinger, 1542** (Sehling 2, p. 174):

The priest goeth before the altar and prayeth the six chief parts of Christian doctrine, as is written above, word for word, and all that are in the church with him. 3. Thereafter three boys and three step forth over against one another, face to face, somewhat higher than the rest, and question one another by way of dialogue.

At the end the priest goes back "before the altar" and prays the six parts once more for the children (Sehling 2, p. 174).

Standing on stools. Regensburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1567 (Sehling 13, p. 464), the Wednesday catechism:

Thereupon two boys stand up upon stools set over against one another for the purpose, of whom the one asketh and the other answereth, and reciteth right slowly, plainly and clearly, with a loud voice, the bare text of the whole catechism, of all six parts. After this two others stand up.

About five pairs are set up in turn.

Boys on the men's side, girls on the women's. Henneberg, *Kirchenordnung* of Count Georg Ernst, 1582 (Sehling 2, p. 311), after the catechism sermon:

Upon this [the preacher shall] go from the pulpit before the altar, and then the schoolmaster with the choir or the whole church shall sing the last stanza of the German hymn *Ein feste Burg* (A mighty fortress is our God; "Praise, honour and glory"); during which the common youth shall go from the place where they stood before into the middle of the church, and set themselves, the boys on the men's side and the maidens on the women's side.

Four scholars then step up "to a convenient place, where they can be well heard by every one", and afterward return "in seemly silence to the choir" (Sehling 2, p. 311).

Two choirs of children. Strasbourg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1598 (Sehling 20/1, p. 692):

But in the aforesaid classes or divisions of the catechism the boys and daughters which are come equally far in learning are always set over against one another, as it were in two choirs.

Each child who has recited receives "a new Strasbourg penny", and those who know the whole catechism with the table of duties and the psalms or hymns "a new kreuzer" (Sehling 20/1, p. 692). The children are to answer "finely loud and clearly" and, while others recite, to listen "still and seemly" and repeat everything silently.

Kneeling with folded hands. Heilbronn asks for a posture of prayer from the children called out to pray. **Heilbronn, *Kirchenordnung*, 1543** (Sehling 17/1, p. 315):

And the young boys out of the Latin school [shall pray] Latin, and those out of the German school German [prayers]; two or three at a time shall be called forth by the deacon, which shall pray devoutly, kneeling, with folded hands.

This is the only place in the corpus where the hands of those praying in an office or catechism service are prescribed.

The rest.

- **Pairs.** The children are set "pair by pair" to ask one another the questions at the early Sunday catechism in Schwäbisch Hall (1543; Sehling 17/1, p. 162). The Württemberg order for the German schools (1559) sets them "boys against boys, girls against girls, against one another", in school, so that they may recite "in the church at the time of the catechism also publicly before the congregation" (Sehling 17/1, p. 584). At Rothenberg (1618) the schoolboys recite the table of duties "with questions and answers against one another" (Sehling 13, p. 548).
- **Stepping out.** At Schweinfurt (1543) "the scholars shall also step out against one another", only those "who have good speech and speak out strongly"; the shy are to be heard in school, "else … it would at last become a mockery" (Sehling 11, p. 642).
- **Standing or kneeling at the altar.** In the Schillingsfürst order (before 1578), "after the collect the children stand or kneel at the altar" and repeat the chief parts after the pastor (Sehling 15, p. 227). In Hohenlohe (1596) the pastor, after hearing some children, is "stand again before the altar" to repeat the main points of the sermon (Sehling 15, p. 663).
- **A girl leads.** In the Torgau girls' school (1575), after the morning blessing and the *Veni creator* (Come, Creator), "daily one little girl shall stand up", one girl stands up every day and prays the five parts aloud for the others to repeat (Sehling 1, p. 685).

10.12.8 The sign of the cross: at home, not in choir

No office or catechism service in the corpus prescribes the sign of the cross in church. It survives in the morning and evening blessings of Luther's Small Catechism, the household office, and there the orders divide.

Kept and defended. The Kurland order asks the households to keep the morning and evening blessing with the sign. **Kurland, *Kurländische Kirchenordnung*, 1570** (Sehling 5, p. 91):

Every man, and especially the young children, shall be held to the morning and evening blessing, and that without contempt of the sign of the holy cross, which signs are, without any superstition, *signa fidei, religionis et confessionis nostrae* (signs of our faith, religion and confession), the banner and ensign of Christians.

Printed in the catechism. The Palatinate order of 1556 prints Luther's rubric whole: "thou shalt bless thyself with the holy cross and say: God the Father, Son and Holy Ghost prevail. Amen. Thereupon say, kneeling or standing, the Creed or the Our Father" (Sehling 14, p. 141).

Struck out. Pfalz-Zweibrücken (1557) prints "thou shalt bless thyself and say"; the editor notes that the draft read "with the holy cross" and that it was struck (Sehling 18, p. 179, n. u). Nördlingen (1579) likewise has only "thou shalt bless thyself and say thus" (Sehling 12, p. 357).

10.12.9 Summary by order

Order	Office or service	What is prescribed	Sehling
Wittenberg 1533	Sunday catechism; Saturday Vespers	catechism read "on both sides, verse by verse"; lessons by three boys	1, p. 703

Order	Office or service	What is prescribed	Sehling
Bremen 1534	evening office	children kneel for the *preces* after the antiphon	7/2.2, p. 463
Schönburg 1542	Matins; weekday catechism	*flexis genibus* (on bended knees) for the prayers; priest before the altar; boys face to face, raised	2, pp. 170, 174
Mecklenburg 1542	Litany after the Sunday sermon	scholars and people kneel and answer	5, p. 149
Heilbronn 1543	catechism after Vespers	boys pray kneeling with folded hands	17/1, p. 315
Schwäbisch Hall 1543	Sunday catechism	children set in pairs	17/1, p. 162
Schweinfurt 1543	Vespers; catechism	lesson read "toward the people"; good speakers step out facing	11, pp. 631, 642
Coburg 1545	Vespers	lesson from pulpit or middle altar	1, p. 543
Cologne 1546 (Moderate Reformed)	Litany on prayer days	boys kneel before an altar	22, p. 45
Stolberg-Königstein 1552	morning lesson	three collects sung kneeling	9, p. 468
Waldeck 1556	Litany after the sermon	scholars or pastor kneel before the altar	9, p. 277
Palatinate 1556	household blessing	sign of the cross; creed kneeling or standing	14, p. 141
Pfalz-Zweibrücken 1557	household blessing	cross struck from the draft	18, p. 179
Palatinate 1563 (Reformed)	morning and evening prayer	"let us … kneel down"	14, pp. 396–397
Herpf 1566	Saturday evening prayer	chapter read before the altar	2, p. 334
Regensburg 1567	Vespers; Wednesday catechism	boys kneel before the altar for *Benedicamus*; pairs stand on stools	13, pp. 461, 464
Pomerania 1569	Saturday Vespers	*Veni sancte Spiritus* (Come, Holy Spirit) and *Da pacem flexis genibus* (Give peace, on bended knees)	4, p. 435
Kurland 1570	household blessing	sign of the cross defended	5, p. 91
Mecklenburg convents 1572	Matins	nuns in stalls facing, verse about verse	5, p. 258
Schwarzburg 1574	Litany	three boys in surplices kneel before the altar	2, p. 134
Torgau 1575	girls' school	one girl stands and leads	1, p. 685
Nördlingen 1579	household blessing	no cross	12, p. 357
Marggrabowa 1581	Friday Litany	two or three boys kneel before the altar	4, p. 149
Henneberg 1582	catechism	youth into the middle of the church, boys and girls apart	2, p. 311
Breslau 1585	evening bell	prayer kneeling in the street	3, p. 405
Hohenlohe 1596	catechism	pastor stands before the altar	15, p. 663
Strasbourg 1598	catechism	children "in two choirs"; a penny for reciting	20/1, p. 692
Isny c. 1600	Litany	"Let us kneel"	17/1, p. 468

Order	Office or service	What is prescribed	Sehling
Palatinate 1601 (Reformed)	morning and evening prayer	"humble ourselves" for "kneel down"	14, p. 572
Lütetsburg 1606 (Reformed)	morning prayer	"nedderkneen"	7/1, p. 541
Rothenberg 1618	catechism	table of duties recited facing	13, p. 548

10.13 Table by order

Key.

- **Hours**: which offices the order provides.
  - "All" = Matins (with Lauds), Prime, Terce, Sext, None, Vespers, Compline.
  - "M+V" = morning and evening offices.
- **Who**: the singers.
- **Lang.**: L = Latin; G = German or Low German; L/G = both.
- **?**: not stated.

Order	Vol.	Hours	Who	Lang.	Notes
Luther, *Von ordenung gottis diensts*, 1523	1	M+V daily; Mass and Vespers on Sunday	priests, scholars, future preachers; all on Sunday	?	Bible in course with exposition; one hour each
Luther, *Formula missae*, 1523	1	All, shortened (3 psalms)	boys; "episcopus" orders	L	daily lessons with vernacular exposition
Wittenberg castle church, 1525	1	All; Vespers + Compline joined	ministers of the foundation	L	Gospels at little hours; no *Deus in adiutorium* (O God, make speed to save me), no *preces*
Luther, *Deutsche Messe*, 1526	1	M+V daily in towns with schools	boys	L, lesson repeated in G	
Braunschweig 1528; Hamburg 1529; Lübeck 1531	6/1; 5	M+V daily (Compline folded in on feasts)	school, cantor	L, lesson in G	half an hour; octonary of Ps 119
Nimbschen convent, 1529	1	Matins, Prime, Terce, Sext on feasts	nuns	?	
Torgau, 1529	1	"private hours"	altarists (formerly schoolmasters)	?	
Ansbach *Gottesdienstmandat* 1531; *Ordnung bei den Stiften* 1533	11	All	canons	L	OT in course at Matins; *preces* dropped
Remse convent, 1533	1	M+V in place of the hours	nuns	G	three psalms, chapter, canticle, collect
Altenburg castle chapter, 1533	1	All, one nocturn	canons	L	Litany for *preces*

Order	Vol.	Hours	Who	Lang.	Notes
Wittenberg town, 1533	1	M+V; Saturday and Sunday Vespers	boys; people at Te Deum	L (G only with the people)	prophecy cadence; *Nunc dimittis* figural
Goslar, St Simon and Judas, 1534	7/2.2	All	canons	L	not reduced; vigils for the dead abolished
Pomerania, *Kirchenordnung*, 1535	4	M+V in parishes	boys	L	"enough for the parish churches"
Pomerania, *Pia ordinatio*, 1535 (Denmark 1537; Schleswig-Holstein 1542; Braunschweig-Wolfenbüttel 1543)	4; 23; 6/1	All	remaining monks and canons	L	Bible twice a year; Compline recited; vigils for the dead forbidden
Lippe 1538; Mecklenburg 1552	21; 5	chapters "not burdened"	—	—	preaching in their place
Leipzig friaries and convents, 1539	1	"seven hours" *de tempore* (of the season)	friars (doors locked), religious	?	
Brandenburg, 1540	3	All, "nothing omitted" *de tempore*	chapters, convents, parishes	L	diocesan Breviary, old choir books; an office of Job lessons after burials
Stendal 1540; Cölln 1540; Salzwedel 1541	3	hours *de tempore* daily	vicars and beneficed priests	L	on pain of losing the benefice
Naumburg cathedral, c. 1541–1543	2	All	chapter, scholars, people	L, lesson in G	German chapter and people's psalm
Spandau convent, 1541	3	Matins, Prime, Terce, Sext, None	nuns	?	Breviary corrected; catechism in refectory
Crevese convent, 1541	3	Hours *de tempore*; Litany after Prime	nuns	?	Litany Sunday, Monday, Wednesday, Friday
Calenberg convents, 1542	6/2	All; Lauds Sundays only	nuns	?	
Frankenberg convent, 1542	7/2.2	Matins, little hours etc., "in place of the hours"	nuns, voluntary	L	vigils dropped
Pomerania, *Karcken ordening*, 1542	4	Saturday and eve Vespers	boys, chaplain	L	Latin Litany for the *Magnificat* in Advent and Lent; *Da pacem* (Give peace)
Pfalz-Neuburg 1543; Heidelberg 1546	13; 14	All, where customary	chapters, convents, parishes	L; G lessons in parishes; G psalmody for nuns	nine lessons in course

Order	Vol.	Hours	Who	Lang.	Notes
Quakenbrück (Bonnus), 1543	7/1	All	canons, scholars	L	vigils and prayers for the dead omitted
Merseburg synod, 1544	2	—	pastors	—	exhorted to daily prayer and psalter
Zwickau, 1545	1	hospital hours abolished	preacher with the poor	G	psalm and lesson daily
Lüneburg convents, 1555	6/1	All	nuns	L	corrected Breviary (*Emendatio*)
Senftenberg, 1555	1	M+V daily; Sunday Matins	school	L, lesson in G	German responsory
Öhringen chapter, 1556	15	All	canons	L	
Breslau, 1557 (report)	3	hours of the Passion; Friday hours of the Visitation	choralists	L	
Württemberg cloister schools, 1559	16	*preces*; morning and evening office	students	L	psalter in course; *Benedictus* / *Quicunque* alternately
Tübingen Stipendium, 1559	17/1	morning and evening psalms	stipendiaries	?	psalter recited in course
Mecklenburg, *Conformitas*, c. 1560	5	—	choir	—	Lossius's *Psalmodia* required
Feuchtwangen chapter, 1563	11	Matins and Lauds daily; little hours lapsed, then one a day	canons	L	psalter monthly
Prussia, 1568	4	Saturday, Sunday and weekday Vespers	boys; village pastors	L, lesson in G; G in villages	boys learn to speak before the people
Pomerania *Agenda*, 1569	4	Vespers	school, organist	L/G	organ alternation
Keppel convent (Nassau), 1570	10	All	nuns, taught by the preacher	G	Leipzig psalm-books with notes
Mecklenburg convents, 1572	5	daily office in place of the hours	nuns, domina in turn	G	German *preces* daily; psalter monthly, OT yearly, NT thrice
Lippe 1571; Oldenburg 1573	21; 7/2.1	Vespers in villages; summer Matins	pastor, sexton, boys, people	G	
Oldenburg, 1573	7/2.1	Vespers	school, organist	L/G	Spangenberg or Lossius required
Lüneburg convents, 1574	6/1	All	nuns	L/G	3 Latin + 1 German psalm at Matins

Order	Vol.	Hours	Who	Lang.	Notes
Pfalz-Neuburg *Generalartikel*, 1576	13	Saturday and feast-eve Vespers	pastor	?	even "if no one came"
Saxony, 1580	1	Saturday Vespers, Sunday Matins; weekday M+V in great towns	Latin school; then German school	L; G (weekday)	
Hoya, 1581	6/2	Sunday Vespers	school, organist	L/G	sermon inside Vespers
Leeden convent, 1585	22	morning prayer daily	conventuals with pastor	?	psalm, chapter, exposition
Lohr (Rieneck), 1588	11	First Vespers of Sundays and feasts	youth	L	Lossius; psalms explained in school
Hof, 1592	11	Vespers; daily early service	scholars, boys and girls	L/G	figural option; German *Magnificat* tone 6
Verden cathedral, 1606	7/1	Matins and Vespers on Saturdays, Sundays, feasts	cathedral choir	L	"as the old order bringeth with it"

10.14 Concordance of the orders quoted

Every order quoted or cited in this chapter is listed below by region. The table gives:

- **Sehling**: the volume and pages in Sehling's edition.
- **Doc**: the `eko.db` document that holds the text, for full-text lookup. A single database record may hold several orders.
- **§**: the sections where the order is quoted or cited.

Saxony, Thuringia and central Germany

Order	Sehling	Doc	§
Wittenberg, *Kirchen-Ordnung*, 1522	1, p. 697	146	10.9.1, 10.9.3, 10.9.4
Luther, *Von ordenung gottis diensts in der gemeine*, 1523	1, pp. 2–3	2	10.3.1, 10.6.4
Luther, *Formula missae et communionis*, 1523	1, p. 9	2	10.3.2
Coburg, *Gottesdienst-Ordnung* (proposal), 1524	1, p. 543	73	10.9.3
Luther, *Deutsche Messe und ordnung gottis diensts*, 1526	1, pp. 13–14	3	10.3.3, 10.8.1, 10.10.1
Ernestine Saxony, deliberations for the visitation (Sehling's introduction)	1, p. 38	6	10.4.1
Wittenberg, *Wie es einer zeit mit den ceremonien der kirchen gehalten wirt*, 1525	1, pp. 698–699	147	10.4.1, 10.7.1, 10.7.5, 10.11.4
Ernestine Saxony, *Unterricht der visitatoren an die pfarrherrn*, 1528	1, pp. 164, 167	9	10.3.4, 10.9.2

Order	Sehling	Doc	§
Nimbschen, *Verordnung der Visitatoren für das Kloster*, 1529	1, p. 617	110	10.4.4
Torgau, *Ordnung der Visitatoren*, 1529	1, p. 677	139	10.5.3
Belzig, *Ordnung der Stadt Belzig*, 1529	1, p. 527	63	10.7.5
Eilenburg, visitation order, 1529	1, p. 560	82	10.7.5
Niemegk, *Verordnung der Visitatoren*, 1529	1, p. 616	110	10.7.5
Kloster Remse, *Ein kurze christliche ordnung in das junkfrau closter*, 1533	1, p. 652	125	10.7.5, 10.8.2
Altenburg, *Verordnung … fur den stift aufm schloss*, 1533	1, p. 515	56	10.4.2, 10.7.5
Wittenberg, *Kirchen-Ordnung für die Stadt Wittenberg*, 1533	1, pp. 700–705	148	10.5.2, 10.6.1, 10.7.5, 10.8.1, 10.10.1, 10.10.7, 10.11.1, 10.11.3, 10.11.4, 10.12.5, 10.12.6
Naumburg, *Kirchen-Ordnung für die St. Wenzelskirche*, 1537	2, p. 72	1219	10.10.4, 10.10.7
Freiberg, *Visitationsartikel des Dr. Jacob Schenk*, 1537	1, p. 466	48	10.9.2
Leipzig, *Visitations-Artikel für die Klöster*; *Gemeines Fürhalten*, 1539	1, pp. 589–590	97, 98	10.4.4
Albertine Saxony, *Kirchenordnunge zum anfang* (Duke Henry), 1539	1, p. 564	85	10.5.2
Wurzen, *Gemeine Artikel*, 1542	2, p. 98	1223	10.9.2
Naumburg, *Gottesdienst-Ordnung in der Domkirche*, 1543 (1541?)	2, p. 596	1265	10.4.2, 10.6.4, 10.8.1
Merseburg, synodal decree, 1544	2, p. 13	1211	10.6.5
Zwickau, *Ordenung der pfarren und kirchen*, 1545	1, p. 725	154	10.5.1
Schönburg lordships, church order of Johann Pfeffinger, 1542	2, pp. 170, 174	1235	10.5.3, 10.12.2, 10.12.7
Coburg, *Verordnung und bestellung des kirchendiensts*, 1545	1, p. 543	73	10.7.5, 10.12.6
Senftenberg, *Kirchen-Ordnung für die Stadt Senftenberg*, 1555	1, pp. 671–672	136	10.5.2, 10.7.1
Sangerhausen, *Verordnung der Visitatoren*, 1555	1, p. 658	128	10.10.2, 10.10.4, 10.10.7
Pirna, *Kirchenordnung* of Anton Lauterbach, 1555	1, p. 644	119	10.9.5
Obermaßfeld (Henneberg), the pastor's account of his services, 1563	2, p. 343	1249	10.10.2
Ermsleben, *Kirchen-Ordnung der Stadt Ermsleben*, 1564	2, p. 486	1260	10.9.5

Order	Sehling	Doc	§
Sulzfeld and Klein-Bardorf (Henneberg), *Kirchen-Ordnung*, 1566	2, p. 353	1250	10.10.4, 10.10.7
Herpf (Henneberg), *Kirchen-Ordnung*, 1566	2, p. 334	1248	10.12.6
Gottleuba, *Verzeichnus der kirchenordnung*, 1567	1, p. 568	87	10.10.4
Dresden, *Gottesdienst-Ordnung der Kreuzkirche*, 1574	1, p. 555	78	10.7.5
Brandis, *Gottesdienst-Ordnung*, 1574	1, p. 534	67	10.10.2
Schwarzburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1574	2, p. 134	1230	10.12.3
Penig, *Kirchenordnung*, 1575	1, p. 634	116	10.10.4, 10.10.7
Torgau, visitation order, 1575: the girls' school	1, p. 685	141	10.12.7
Albertine Saxony, *Ordnung* of Duke August, 1580	1, pp. 368, 369, 370, 393, 422	44	10.5.2, 10.5.3, 10.6.5, 10.10.4, 10.10.5
Henneberg, *Kirchenordnung* of Count Georg Ernst, 1582	2, p. 311	1247	10.12.7

Franconia, Swabia and the Palatinate

Order	Sehling	Doc	§
Nördlingen, *Renovatio Ecclesiae Nordlingiacensis*, 1525 (and the editors' note)	12, pp. 298, 305	370	10.9.1, 10.9.2
Strasbourg, the council's measures of 1525 (Sehling's introduction) (Moderate Reformed)	20/1, p. 45	1275	10.9.2
Brandenburg-Ansbach-Kulmbach, *Landtagsabschied*, 1526 (and the editors' note)	11, p. 94	259	10.9.1, 10.9.3
Schwäbisch Hall, *Kirchenordnung*, 1527	17/1, p. 60	755	10.9.1, 10.9.6
Heilbronn, the council's measures of 1529 (Sehling's introduction)	17/1, pp. 225–226	765	10.9.3
Heilbronn, *Confessio Heilbronnensis* and *Kirchenordnung*, 1530	17/1, pp. 278–279	770	10.9.1, 10.9.2
Brandenburg-Ansbach-Kulmbach, *Gottesdienstmandat*, 1531	11, pp. 311–312	275	10.4.2
Heilbronn, draft *Gottesdienstordnung*, 1532	17/1, p. 302	778	10.7.5
Brandenburg-Ansbach-Kulmbach, *Ordnung singens und lesens bei den Stiften*, 1533	11, pp. 313–316	276	10.4.2, 10.7.1, 10.7.5
Brandenburg-Nürnberg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1533	11, pp. 171, 203, 206	270	10.3.4, 10.9.5, 10.10.5
Württemberg, *Kastenordnung*, 1536	16, p. 96	650	10.9.4
Strasbourg, *Gottesdienstordnung*, 1542 (Moderate Reformed)	20/1, p. 326	1311	10.9.5
Pfalz-Neuburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1543	13, pp. 77–78, 90	386	10.4.2, 10.7.2, 10.8.2, 10.8.3, 10.9.5, 10.11.1

Order	Sehling	Doc	§
Schwäbisch Hall, *Kirchenordnung*, 1543	17/1, pp. 162–163, 170	762	10.6.4, 10.10.2, 10.10.5, 10.10.7, 10.12.7
Heilbronn, *Kirchenordnung*, 1543	17/1, p. 315	781	10.12.7
Schweinfurt, *Kirchenordnung*, 1543	11, pp. 631, 642	304	10.12.6, 10.12.7
Nördlingen, *Ordnung der ceremonien in der pfarkirchen zu Sant Georgen*, 1544	12, p. 319	373	10.10.3, 10.10.7
Nürnberg, *Agendbüchlein* of Veit Dietrich, 1545	11, pp. 504, 528	297	10.9.1, 10.10.2, 10.10.5
Donauwörth, *Kirchenordnung*, 1545	12, p. 160	351	10.9.1, 10.9.4
Kurpfalz, *Bedenken zur Reformation der Stiftskirchen*, 1546	14, pp. 91–92	470	10.4.2, 10.9.3, 10.9.4
Strasbourg, *Übereinkunft der Geistlichen zu Lehre, Zensur und Gottesdienstgestaltung*, 1548 (Moderate Reformed; on the Interim)	20/1, p. 355	1316	10.10.5
Regensburg, *Kirchenordnung* under Justus Jonas, 1553	13, p. 421	440	10.10.4
Württemberg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1553	16, pp. 243, 246	671	10.10.2, 10.10.3, 10.10.7
Hohenlohe, *Kirchenordnung*, 1553	15, pp. 68, 80	539	10.9.1, 10.9.2, 10.9.6
Öhringen, *Reformation und Ordnung des Öhringer Stifts*, 1556	15, p. 102	545	10.4.2
Kurpfalz, *Kirchenordnung*, 1556	14, p. 141	480	10.12.8
Kurpfalz, *Reformationsmandat an die Amtleute* of Ottheinrich, 16 April 1556	14, p. 112	475	10.9.2
Pfalz-Zweibrücken, *Kirchenordnung*, 1557	18, p. 179	967	10.12.8
Hohenlohe, *Visitations- und Kirchenordnung*, 1558	15, p. 125	549	10.9.5
Rothenburg ob der Tauber, *Kirchenordnung*, 1559	11, p. 591	301	10.3.4
Württemberg, *Ordnung der deutschen Schulen*, 1559 (supplement to vol. 16)	17/1, p. 584	813	10.12.7
Regensburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1567	13, pp. 461, 464	450	10.12.2, 10.12.7
Schillingsfürst, *Kirchenordnung* in use until 1578	15, p. 227	567	10.12.7
Württemberg, *Ordnung der Klosterschulen*, 1559 (with the 1582 variants)	16, pp. 365–367	683	10.6.6, 10.11.4
Tübingen, *Ordnung des Tübinger Stipendiums*, 1559, statutes (supplement to vol. 16)	17/1, p. 562	813	10.6.6
Neckarbischofsheim, *Kirchenordnung*, 1560	16, p. 672	742	10.10.2, 10.10.3, 10.10.7
Feuchtwangen, chapter order, 1563	11, p. 402	293	10.5.3, 10.7.1
Palatinate, *Kirchenordnung*, 1563 (Reformed)	14, pp. 342, 396–397	499, 504	10.10.5, 10.10.6, 10.10.7, 10.12.2

Order	Sehling	Doc	§
Pfalz-Veldenz, *Kirchenordnung*, 1574	18, p. 523	1011	10.10.2, 10.10.3, 10.10.7
Wolfstein, *Christliche Instructio des Thomas Stieber*, 1574	13, p. 586	463	10.9.2
Pfalz-Neuburg, *Generalartikel*, 1576	13, p. 178	404	10.6.5
Nördlingen, *Kirchenordnung*, 1579	12, pp. 357, 375	375	10.10.5, 10.12.8
Rieneck, *Vesperordnung zu Lohr*, 1588	11, p. 699	318	10.8.1, 10.11.2
Hohenlohe, Weikersheim orders on the daily prayer, 1588	15, pp. 538–550	604, 605	10.6.5
Hof, *Ordo ecclesiasticus*, 1592	11, pp. 422, 429, 450	294	10.11.2, 10.11.4
Mülhausen, instructions for the schoolmaster and chaplains, 1524 (and Sehling's introduction) (Reformed)	20/2, pp. 161, 163, 197	1374, 1378	10.5.3, 10.9.1, 10.9.3
Mülhausen, opinion of the people's priest and the three preachers on the services, 1528 (Reformed)	20/2, pp. 209–210	1381	10.9.1, 10.9.3
Hohenlohe, *Schul- und Gesangsordnung* of Count Wolfgang, 1596	15, p. 663	629	10.10.2, 10.10.5, 10.10.7, 10.12.7
Strasbourg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1598	20/1, p. 692	1344	10.12.7
Isny, *Agende*, c. 1600	17/1, p. 468	800	10.12.3
Palatinate, *Kirchenordnung*, 1601 (Reformed)	14, pp. 558, 572	515	10.10.2, 10.10.6, 10.10.7, 10.12.2
Limpurg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1610	16, p. 616	729	10.10.2
Rothenberg, *Christliche vereinigung* of the ministers, 1618	13, p. 548	460	10.12.7

Brandenburg, Prussia, Silesia, Pomerania, Mecklenburg

Order	Sehling	Doc	§
Pomesania, *Themata episcopi Risenburgensis*, 1524	4, p. 29	1831	10.9.2
Pomerania, *Kirchenordnung*, 1535	4, pp. 340, 342	1856	10.5.2, 10.7.5, 10.9.2, 10.9.4
Pomerania, *Pia ordinatio caeremoniarum*, 1535	4, pp. 345–350	1857	10.4.3, 10.5.1, 10.7.1, 10.7.5, 10.9.1, 10.9.2, 10.9.4, 10.11.1
Brandenburg, *Kirchen-ordnung* of Joachim II, 1540	3, pp. 71–72, 81	1746	10.4.2, 10.9.5, 10.11.1
Cölln on the Spree, order of 1540	3, p. 156	1755	10.6.2
Stendal, *Verordnung für die übrigen Kirchen*, 1540	3, p. 310	1784	10.6.2
Spandau, *Verordnung für das Kloster*, 1541	3, p. 305	1783	10.4.4, 10.7.5
Salzwedel-Altstadt, *Ordnung und Abschied*, 1541	3, p. 267	1778	10.6.2
Crevese nunnery, recess, 1541	3, p. 203	1762	10.7.5

Order	Sehling	Doc	§
Pomerania, *Karcken ordening*, 1542	4, p. 354	1858	10.7.5
Perleberg, *Visitationsordnung*, 1542	3, p. 245	1774	10.9.4
Mecklenburg, *Verordnung der Visitatoren*, 1542	5, p. 149	1921	10.12.3
Mecklenburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1552	5, pp. 196, 200	1922	10.5.1, 10.10.2, 10.10.3, 10.10.7
Danzig, *Kirchenordnung*, 1557	4, p. 181	1844	10.7.5
Breslau, report on the order of the churches, 1557	3, pp. 404–405	1807	10.4.4
Prenzlau, *Abschied*, 1557	3, p. 261	1776	10.9.5
Neubrandenburg, *Kirchenordnung* of the visitors, 1559	5, p. 269	1929	10.9.5, 10.9.6
Mecklenburg, *Conformitas ceremoniarum*, c. 1560	5, pp. 288–290	1936	10.9.5, 10.10.2, 10.10.7, 10.11.2
Pomerania, *Kerckenordeninge*, 1569	4, pp. 384–385	1862	10.10.2, 10.10.5
Mecklenburg, *Klosterordnung*, 1572	5, pp. 253–254, 257–259	1926	10.5.1, 10.7.1, 10.7.5, 10.8.2, 10.9.2, 10.9.4, 10.12.5
Prussia, *Kirchenordnung und Ceremonien*, 1568	4, pp. 74–75	1833	10.5.2, 10.6.1, 10.6.4, 10.11.1, 10.11.4
Pomerania, *Agenda*, 1569	4, p. 435	1865	10.7.5, 10.11.4, 10.12.2
Kurland, *Kirchenordnung*, 1570	5, pp. 83, 91	1907	10.6.4, 10.12.8
Thorn, *Kirchenordnung*, 1575	4, pp. 236–239	1844	10.7.5, 10.10.2, 10.10.4, 10.10.7
Salzwedel (Altstadt), visitation recess, 1579	3, p. 272	1779	10.7.5
Marggrabowa, *Gottesdienstordnung*, 1581	4, p. 149	1837	10.12.3
Teschen, *Kirchenordnung*, 1584	3, pp. 462–463	1815	10.9.2
Breslau, notice of the council concerning the plague, 1585	3, p. 405	1807	10.12.4

Lower Saxony, Westphalia, Hesse-Nassau and the North

Order	Sehling	Doc	§
Goslar, the commons' grievances, 1525 (Sehling's introduction)	7/2.2, p. 184	2183	10.9.1
Lüneburg, *Artikelbuch*, 1527	6/1, p. 515	1998	10.9.2
Braunschweig, *Kirchenordnung*, 1528	6/1, pp. 399–401	1983	10.5.2, 10.7.3, 10.7.5, 10.8.1, 10.11.1
Hamburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1529	5, pp. 493, 520, 523, 533	1958, 1960	10.5.1, 10.7.5, 10.9.2, 10.9.4
Minden, *Kirchenordnung*, 1530	21, p. 144	1434	10.9.2
Lübeck, *Kirchenordnung*, 1531	5, p. 348	1949	10.7.5
Herford, *Kirchenordnung*, 1532	21, p. 170	1442	10.5.1
Goslar, *Ordnung für das Stundengebet am Stift St. Simon und Judas*, 1534 (and Sehling's introduction)	7/2.2, pp. 199, 263–264	2183, 2194	10.4.2, 10.7.5, 10.8.1, 10.9.4

Order	Sehling	Doc	§
Bremen, *Kirchenordnung*, 1534	7/2.2, pp. 458, 463	2217	10.7.5, 10.12.2
Lippe, *Kirchenordnung*, 1538	21, pp. 312, 343	1459	10.5.1, 10.9.2
Northeim, *Kirchenordnung*, 1539	6/2, p. 932	2047	10.9.2
Calenberg-Göttingen, *Kirchenordnung*, 1542	6/2, p. 760	2033	10.9.2
Calenberg-Göttingen, *Klosterordnung* and the instruction for the visitors, 1542	6/2, pp. 851–852, 858	2037	10.4.4, 10.9.4
Frankenberg at Goslar, *Ordnung für das Frauenkloster*, 1542	7/2.2, pp. 275, 277	2198	10.4.4, 10.7.5, 10.9.4
Schleswig-Holstein, *Kirchenordnung*, 1542	23, pp. 131, 142, 144	1576	10.4.3, 10.5.1, 10.7.5, 10.9.2
Braunschweig-Wolfenbüttel, *Christlike kerken-ordeninge*, 1543	6/1, pp. 49–53, 67–68, 81	1972	10.4.3, 10.5.1, 10.7.5, 10.9.5
Stift Osnabrück, *Ordinatio Magistri Hermanni Bonni* (Quakenbrück), 1543	7/1, p. 229	2097	10.4.2, 10.6.2, 10.7.5, 10.9.4
Osnabrück (city), *Kirchenordnung*, 1543	7/1, p. 256	2099	10.7.5
Hildesheim (city), *Kirchenordnung*, 1544	7/2.1, pp. 849–851, 866	2136, 2137	10.7.5, 10.9.5
Cologne and Paderborn, *Buß-, Fasten-, Bet- und Danktagsordnung*, 1546 (Moderate Reformed)	22, p. 45	1484	10.12.3
Stolberg-Königstein, order of the services, 1552	9, p. 468	2320	10.12.2
Lüneburg, *Reformatio coenobiorum ducatus Luneburgensis*, 1555	6/1, pp. 611–612	2009	10.4.4
Lüneburg, *Emendatio Breviarii virginum ordinis Sancti Benedicti*, 1555	6/1, p. 624	2011	10.4.4
Wittgenstein, *Kirchenordnung*, 1555	22, p. 87	1491	10.9.6
Hamburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1556	5, p. 553	1963	10.7.5
Waldeck, *Kirchenordnung*, 1556	9, p. 277	2300	10.12.3
Schaumburg, *Weisung an die Konvente in Fischbeck und Obernkirchen*, 1562 (and Sehling's introduction)	7/2.2, pp. 35, 60	2158, 2162	10.9.4
Nassau-Dillenburg, *Ordnung für das Kloster Keppel*, 1570 (and Sehling's introduction)	10, pp. 31, 133–134	166, 181	10.8.2, 10.11.3
Emden, Micron's *Ordinancien*, German edition, 1565 (Reformed)	7/1, p. 606	2116	10.10.2, 10.10.6, 10.10.7
Hesse, *Kirchenordnung*, 1566 (Moderate Reformed)	8, pp. 251–253	2257	10.10.2, 10.10.3, 10.10.7
Braunschweig-Wolfenbüttel, *Christlicher und gründlicher bericht* on the convents, 1569 (and the editors' note)	6/1, pp. 312, 334	1978	10.9.1, 10.9.4
Lippe, *Kirchenordnung*, 1571	21, pp. 395–397	1462	10.6.4, 10.8.2, 10.10.2, 10.10.3, 10.10.7
Oldenburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1573	7/2.1, pp. 1085, 1095, 1111, 1113	2149, 2150,	10.6.4, 10.10.2, 10.10.3, 10.11.2,

Order	Sehling	Doc	§
		2151	10.11.4
Harlingerland, *Kirchenordnung*, 1573/74 (the editors' note quoting Luther)	7/1, p. 741	2122	10.9.2
Lüneburg, *Klosterordnung* of Duke Wilhelm the Younger, 1574	6/1, pp. 620–621	2010	10.7.1, 10.8.3
Lüneburg, *Kirchenordnung der Stadt Lüneburg*, 1575	6/1, p. 658	2017	10.11.2
Nassau-Dillenburg, *Agende*, 1575 (Philippist)	10, p. 148	182	10.10.2
Hoya, *Kirchenordnung*, 1581	6/2, p. 1150	2065	10.7.4, 10.11.4
Nassau-Dillenburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1582 (Reformed)	10, p. 163	184	10.9.5
Sayn, *Kirchenzuchtordnung*, 1582	19/1, p. 373	1090	10.9.5
Leeden (Tecklenburg), *Ordnung für das Zisterzienserinnenkloster*, 1585	22, p. 247	1506	10.6.3
Ysenburg-Birstein, *Kirchenordnung*, 1588	10, p. 627	228	10.10.3, 10.10.7
Marienhafe (East Frisia), *Kirchenordnung*, 1593 (the editors' note)	7/1, p. 722	2122	10.9.1
Solms-Laubach, *Kirchenzuchtordnung*, 1603	9, p. 357	2311	10.10.4, 10.10.7
Verden, *Kirchenordnung*, 1606	7/1, p. 153	2089	10.4.2, 10.11.1
Buxtehude, *Agende*, 1565 (Sehling's introduction)	7/1, p. 67	2080	10.11.2
Lütetsburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1606 (Sehling's note) (Reformed)	7/1, p. 541	2115	10.12.2
Hanau-Münzenberg, *Ordnung der Katechisation*, 1609 (Reformed)	10, pp. 487, 491	211	10.10.6, 10.10.7

Transylvania

Order	Sehling	Doc	§
Transylvanian Saxons, *Kirchenordnung*, 1547	24, p. 223	1669	10.7.5
Transylvania, *Articuli de ceremoniis*, 1607	24, p. 494	1726	10.9.5

Chapter 11. Sermons and Preaching

This chapter collects what the evangelical church orders printed in Emil Sehling's *Die evangelischen Kirchenordnungen des XVI. Jahrhunderts* (The Evangelical Church Orders of the Sixteenth Century) say about the **sermon**. It asks:

- What did the reformers and the orders think the sermon was **for**, and what was it to contain?
- **On what occasions** was there preaching: Sundays and feasts, weekdays, the catechism, Lent and the Passion, prayer days, funerals and weddings?
- **What texts** were preached: the old Sunday gospels and epistles, books in course, the catechism, the heads of doctrine?
- **How** was a sermon to be made, and in what manner of speech?
- **How long** was it to last?
- What did the orders say about **postils**, written sermons and preparation?
- What were the limits on **rebuke and controversy** in the pulpit?
- What was done in the pulpit **before and after** the sermon?
- How were **preachers** tested and corrected?
- What was required of the **hearers**?

How the chapter is laid out.

- §11.1 summarizes the findings, and §11.2 sets out the method and cautions.
- §11.3 gives Luther's rulings of 1523 and 1526 and the Saxon visitation of 1528.
- §11.4 covers the occasions and times of preaching, and §11.5 the texts.
- §11.6 covers how to preach, and §11.7 the length of sermons.
- §11.8 deals with postils and preparation, and §11.9 with rebuke and polemic.
- §11.10 covers the pulpit acts around the sermon.
- §11.11 covers preachers, and §11.12 hearers.
- §11.13 is a table by order, and §11.14 a concordance.

11.1 Summary of findings

1. The sermon is the reason for the assembly (§11.3).

- Luther's first rule, in 1523: the congregation "shall never come together" unless God's Word is preached and prayer made. Where the Word is not preached, "it is better that one neither sing nor read nor come together".
- The visitors of 1528 required **repentance** to be preached with forgiveness. Preaching forgiveness alone makes people "secure and fearless". Later orders speak of preaching "repentance, law and gospel".

2. The occasions (§11.4).

- **Sunday and holy days.** The gospel was preached in the morning at the Mass, and the catechism (or the epistle) in the afternoon. Luther's Wittenberg had three Sunday sermons: an early one on the epistle for the servants, the gospel at the Mass, and the Old Testament at Vespers.
- **Weekdays.** One or two weekday sermons, usually Wednesday and Friday (1528). Great towns had more. Early sermons were held for servants and craftsmen before work. Village weekday sermons were often suspended at harvest, or held only in winter.
- **The catechism.** The catechism sermon came on Sunday afternoon, and was also preached through in series several times a year (Torgau: every quarter; Reutlingen: four times a year).
- **Lent and the Passion.** Luther refused "eight hours" of Passion preaching on Good Friday: an hour a day in Holy Week. The later orders divide the Passion harmony into a fixed series of sermons (six in Lent at Henneberg; three on Maundy Thursday and Good Friday at Coburg).
- **Prayer days** (*Bettage*), weekly or monthly, with a sermon of repentance.
- **Funeral sermons** spread from the 1550s. They were to be short, without praise of the dead, and often limited to half an hour. Some towns abolished them.
- **Wedding sermons**: allowed if "short, chaste, Christian", or abolished.

3. The texts (§11.5).

- The Lutheran orders **kept the Sunday gospels and epistles**. Luther's reason was that few preachers could handle a whole book "mightily and profitably".
- **Books in course** were preached at Vespers and on weekdays.
- Some orders also asked for the *loci communes* to be covered through the year. The Reformed Palatinate allowed a book in course on Sunday too.

4. How to preach (§11.6). The orders describe one shape:

- prayer;
- the text;
- a short summary;
- one to three doctrines;
- their application to the hearers;
- a brief repetition;
- the general prayer.

The sermon is to teach, reprove and comfort: to terrify the secure and comfort the troubled. It is to be in plain words, "so that he may be understood", fitted to the hearers, "in good German".

5. Length (§11.7).

- **The chief Sunday sermon: one hour at most**, often three quarters.
- **Weekday, afternoon, catechism, funeral and wedding sermons: half an hour.**
- The reason given is the hearer. "The common people can in no wise remain attentive longer" (Augsburg 1537, Moderate Reformed). The common man is like "a sick man, to whom one must set things often, but little at once" (Württemberg 1536). "Long sermons … weaken the memory and make the hearers weary" (Regensburg 1572).
- Sermons were to be shorter in winter cold (Castell 1579). Overrunning to an hour and a half drew complaints (Hohenlohe 1594).

6. Postils (§11.8). There are two phases.

- **Early.** Luther thought it best to read his postil from the pulpit, for weak preachers and against the sects. Saxony in 1545 told poor village pastors to read Corvinus or Luther's *Hauspostille* "until" they could preach themselves.
- **Later.** The complaint reverses: young preachers "adorn themselves with strange feathers" (Saxony 1580). Pastors are to write their own sermons (Nassau-Dillenburg 1570), to use "pure postils" without leaning on them (Wolfstein 1574), and not to go up into the pulpit "without foregoing meditation" (Sponheim 1608).

7. Rebuke and controversy (§11.9).

- Preachers were to rebuke vices "in general", and **name no one**. Names were read from the pulpit only for excommunication by sentence of the consistory, and in the banns.
- No private grudges in the pulpit.
- The doctrinal quarrels brought mandates against "railing and condemning": "disputations belong in the universities, and not in the churches in the pulpit" (Ansbach 1570).

8. Around the sermon (§11.10). The orders kept the medieval group of vernacular pulpit pieces around the sermon:

- **before**: an exhortation and prayer, often the Our Father or "Nun bitten wir" (Now pray we); in the Palatinate (Reformed) the apostolic greeting;
- **after**: the open confession and absolution, the general prayer with particular intercessions, and the notices and banns.

9. Preachers (§11.11).

- Candidates passed an examination and a **trial sermon**.
- Pastors already in office preached practice sermons on set texts before the superintendent (Saxony 1577).
- In the Palatine class conventions (1587, Reformed) a colleague's sermon was **censured point by point**: division of the text, scope, digressions, pace, "good German".

10. Hearers (§11.12).

- Attendance was a duty, enforced by counting and fines (one person per house at weekday sermons, Ysenburg 1588).
- Taverns were shut and trade, games and labour service forbidden during the sermon.
- Chattering, sleeping, coming late and leaving early were fined (Ysenburg-Ronneburg 1591, Reformed).
- The people were to be exhorted to stay to the end of the service.

11.2 Scope, sources and cautions

What was searched. The `eko.db` database was searched for the sermon by its names, in High and Low German and Latin spellings:

- *predig* (sermon), *predigt* (sermon), *predigen* (preach), *sermon*, *concio* (sermon);
- *Frühpredigt* (early sermon), *Mittagspredigt* (midday sermon), *Vesperpredigt* (Vespers sermon), *Wochenpredigt* (weekday sermon), *Katechismuspredigt* (catechism sermon), *Passionspredigt* (Passion sermon), *Bettag* (prayer day), *Leichpredigt* (funeral sermon), *Hochzeitpredigt* (wedding sermon), *Brautpredigt* (bridal sermon), *Probpredigt* (trial sermon).

It was also searched for:

- length (*stund*, *halbe stund*, *drei viertel*);
- books and preparation (*postill*, *concipiren*, *meditation*);
- rebuke and controversy (*canzel* with *schelten*, *schmehen*, *lestern*, *mit namen*, *privat affect*, *disputation*);
- the pulpit acts (*vater unser* before the sermon, *Ave Maria*, *Gnad, fried*, *abkündigung*, *gemein gebet*);
- the hearers (*unter der predigt* with *schenken*, *zechen*, *kaufen*, *spazieren*, *schwätzen*, *schlafen*, and fines).

The passages were then read in context, and their orders identified from Sehling's running heads.

Related chapters.

- Chapter 8 covers the hymns before the sermon ("Nun bitten wir", §8.10) and after it ("Erhalt uns, Herr", §8.11).
- Chapter 4 covers the epistle and gospel lessons on which the Sunday sermon was preached (§4.5).
- Chapter 6 covers the general prayer said from the pulpit after the sermon.
- Chapter 10 covers the daily lessons with exposition (§10.3.1) and the sermon inside Vespers (§10.7.4).
- Chapter 12 covers the half-holidays kept "with a sermon", Lent and the other seasons, and the days of fasting and prayer.
- Chapter 16 covers the deacons and chaplains who preached the lesser sermons.
- Chapter 17 covers the oaths by which preachers bound their doctrine to Scripture and the confessions.
- Chapter 15 covers the pastor's study and books, the training of preachers, and the hearers' duties (§§15.3.2, 15.7, 15.8.1).
- Chapter 13 covers the wedding and funeral rites in which those sermons stood, and the council-election sermon (§§13.7, 13.9, 13.13.1).
- Chapter 9 covers the sermon glass (§9.5.9).
- Chapter 3 covers prayers before and after the sermon in the communion service (§3.6.4).

Cautions. Five things limit what the corpus can show:

- **Church orders are not sermons.** Sehling prints rules, visitation articles and reports, not sermons or homiletic handbooks. The orders say what was required and what went wrong. How sermons actually sounded must be learned from the printed sermons and postils, which lie outside the corpus.
- **Silence is not absence.** Many orders say only "the sermon follows". Lengths, days and methods are stated where someone thought them in doubt. A missing rule does not mean that there was no custom.
- **Complaints are evidence of the rule.** The many complaints (sermons of an hour and a half, borrowed postils, railing from the pulpit, empty weekday sermons, taverns open during the sermon) show the abuses the rules were made against. They do not show how common the abuses were.
- **Orders of other traditions.** Sehling prints Reformed orders for the Palatinate, Hesse-Kassel, Nassau, Ysenburg, Hanau, Anhalt, East Frisia and the Lower Rhine, the Moderate Reformed orders of the Upper German cities and Philip's Hesse, and the Philippist orders of Bremen and of Hesse under Philip's sons. They are cited here where they bear on the same questions (the Palatine class conventions, the greeting, books in course, the length of the sermon), and each is marked with its tradition. The wider Reformed practice of Sunday preaching in course is noted but not pursued.

- **Dates.** Several texts survive in later copies, or are pastors' reports undated except by the visitation. Their dates are given as Sehling gives them.

11.3 Luther and the visitors: the sermon first

11.3.1 1523: no gathering without the Word

The first rule. Luther's first sketch of a reformed service names three abuses: the Word was silenced, fables filled the silence, and the service was done as a work. From this he draws the rule on which every later order rests. The congregation is never to meet unless God's Word is preached and prayer is made, "though it be most briefly". **Luther, *Von ordenung gottis diensts in der gemeine*, 1523** (Sehling 1, p. 2):

Three great abuses are fallen into the service of God. The first, that God's word hath been kept silent, and [men have] only read and sung in the churches; that is the worst abuse. [...] Now to put away these abuses, it is first to be known that the Christian congregation shall never come together, except God's word be there preached and prayer made, be it also most briefly. [...] Therefore where God's word is not preached, it is better that one neither sing nor read nor come together.

The same treatise makes the daily morning and evening gatherings into a lesson with its exposition (see Chapter 10 §10.3.1). Preaching is the reason for the assembly, not an ornament of it.

11.3.2 1526: three sermons on a Sunday

The Wittenberg Sunday. In the *Deutsche Messe* (German Mass) Luther sets out the Sunday he had in Wittenberg. There are three sermons:

- at five or six, after psalms "as at Matins", on the **epistle**, for the household servants who cannot come later;
- at the Mass, at eight or nine, on the **gospel**;
- at Vespers in the afternoon, on the **Old Testament** "in order, one after another".

Luther, *Deutsche Messe und ordnung gottis diensts*, 1526 (Sehling 1, p. 13):

On the holy day or Sunday we let remain the customary epistles and gospels, and have three sermons. Early, at five or six, certain psalms are sung, as at Matins. Thereafter the epistle of the day is preached, most of all for the household servants' sake, that they also may be provided for and hear God's word, if haply they could not be at the other sermons. [...] At the Mass, at eight or nine, the gospel is preached which the season giveth through the year. In the afternoon, at Vespers, before the *Magnificat*, the Old Testament is preached in order, one after another.

The same pattern of morning, Mass and Vespers sermons runs through the town orders for the rest of the century (§11.4.1). The Vespers sermon of the north German towns is described in Chapter 10 §10.7.4.

11.3.3 The visitors of 1528: repentance and faith, Wednesday and Friday

What to preach. The *Unterricht der Visitatoren* (Instruction of the Visitors) of 1528 begins its doctrine with a complaint. Many preach only the forgiveness of sins and leave out repentance, and the people grow "secure and fearless". **Ernestine Saxony, *Unterricht der visitatoren an die pfarrherrn*, 1528** (Sehling 1, p. 152):

For Christ saith, in the last chapter of Luke, that repentance and forgiveness of sins should be preached in his name. But many now speak only of the forgiveness of sins, and say nothing, or little, of repentance. Whereas without repentance there is no forgiveness of sins. Neither can forgiveness of sins be understood without repentance. And when forgiveness of sins is preached without repentance, it followeth that the people ween they have already obtained forgiveness of sins, and become thereby secure and fearless.

When to preach. The same book fixes the week. Besides the Sunday morning and Vespers sermons, there is to be preaching on **Wednesday and Friday**, from "useful and not hard books". **Ernestine Saxony, *Unterricht der visitatoren an die pfarrherrn*, 1528** (Sehling 1, p. 168):

In the week one shall preach on Wednesday and Friday. A pastor shall also apply diligence that useful and not hard books be taken in hand to preach. [And] that faith also be so preached, that true Christian repentance, God's judgement, the fear of God and good works […] be not forgotten; for without repentance one cannot have or understand faith. On the holy day one shall preach in the morning and at Vespers: in the morning the gospel; in the afternoon, because the servants and the young folk come into the church, we hold it good that on Sunday afternoon one continually, over and over, preach and expound the Ten Commandments, the articles of the faith and the Our Father.

These two passages set the pattern for the century: gospel on Sunday morning, catechism in the afternoon, and one or two weekday sermons, with repentance preached together with faith.

11.4 Occasions and times

11.4.1 Sundays and feasts: the gospel in the morning, the catechism after noon

The standard Sunday. By mid-century the standard parish Sunday has two sermons:

- in the morning, on the **gospel** of the day, with the Lord's Supper when there are communicants;
- in the afternoon, on the **catechism** (in towns often the epistle instead, or both).

Where the young people cannot come on weekdays because of the field work, the catechism is kept for Sunday and the epistle moves to a weekday. **Albertine Saxony, *General-Artikel und gemeiner Bericht*, 1557** (Sehling 1, p. 323):

they shall so order and dispose their sermons, that always on the Sundays and other Christian feasts the gospel be preached early, and, where communicants be present, the office [of the Mass] be held, but in the afternoon the catechism be at all times preached and exercised, and otherwise in the week also on one day [there] be preaching once. And whereas the young folk in the week, by reason of the tilling of the fields or other work, could not easily come into the church, the catechism shall be expounded on Sunday afternoon, and the epistle on another day in the week

The great towns had more. Wittenberg in 1533 had preaching on Monday, Tuesday, Thursday and Friday mornings (Sehling 1, p. 701).

11.4.2 Weekday sermons

One or two a week. The weekday sermon (*Wochenpredigt*) is required almost everywhere. Its usual days are Wednesday and Friday, or one of them. In the villages it is often suspended when the fields need the people. **Schlieben, *Kirchen-Ordnung für die Stadt Schlieben*, 1529** (Sehling 1, p. 659):

On Thursday in the week a sermon is made, except in midsummer by reason of the people's needful work, and in midwinter by reason of the people; then it is left off. At the beginning a German hymn is sung, whereby the people may gather. 2. The sermon followeth, wherein either the catechism is handled, that it may be preached through in one year, or, if apostles' days fall which are not kept solemnly, the same gospel is preached on such a day in the week, or the Sunday epistle. In Lent the history of the Passion is used for it.

Reutlingen turns the rule round. The village pastors are to preach a weekday sermon in **winter**, "when there is no special business in the field". **Reutlingen, *Kirchenordnung*, c. 1531** (Sehling 17/2, p. 42):

This shall also be laid upon the pastors in the villages, that they also preach the catechism four times in the year, on the holy days after the morning meal; moreover, that in winter time, when there is no special business in the field, every week wherein is no holy day, they also do a sermon on a working day, according to the occasion of each place.

The early sermon for working people. In the towns an early weekday sermon (*Frühpredigt*) was held before the day's work, for servants, day labourers and craftsmen, and kept to half an hour. **Zwickau, *Verordnung der Visitatoren*, 1556** (Sehling 1, p. 726):

The two chaplains in Our Lady's parish church shall hold the early sermon three days in the week for the servants, day labourers and craftsmen, namely Tuesday, Friday and Saturday, because on the other three days there is preaching anyhow. Likewise shall the two at St Katharine's also do in their parish church, and in both churches not draw out the sermon longer than half an hour.

Late in the century the weekday sermon was often badly attended. The counts of Ysenburg and others required at least one person from each house to be present (§11.12.1).

11.4.3 Catechism sermons

Every Sunday afternoon, and in series. The catechism sermon (*Katechismuspredigt*) is normally the Sunday afternoon sermon (§11.4.1). Many orders add a series in which the whole catechism is preached through in a few weeks. Reutlingen has it "four times in the year" (§11.4.2). At Torgau the four deacons preached the Small Catechism every quarter, for a fortnight on end. **Torgau, *Verordnung der Visitatoren von 1575*** (Sehling 1, p. 683):

The pastor in the hospital, Herr Joachim Sella, expoundeth the Sunday gospel at the early sermon on Sunday; on Thursday, through the whole year, he explaineth Luther's catechism. The Small Catechism is every quarter, fourteen days one after another in the week, preached and explained in order by the four deacons.

The catechism sermon was often followed by an examination of the children (*Kinderlehre*, *examen*). Its length was usually set at half an hour (§11.7.2).

11.4.4 Lent and the Passion

Luther: not eight hours on Good Friday. The *Deutsche Messe* (German Mass) keeps Lent and the Passion gospels, but not the old Holy Week. Holy Week shall be "like other weeks", save that the Passion is preached an hour a day. **Luther, *Deutsche Messe und ordnung gottis diensts*, 1526** (Sehling 1, p. 16):

yet not so that one keep the Lenten veil, the shooting of palms, the covering of images, and whatever more there is of that juggling work, or sing four Passions, or have to preach eight hours on the Passion on Good Friday; but Holy Week shall be even as other weeks, save that the Passion be preached an hour a day through the week, or on as many days as one listeth, and that whosoever will receive the sacrament.

The Passion harmony in series. The later orders divide the Passion history into a fixed number of sermons. Henneberg 1582 has six in Lent, the first on Quinquagesima as a summary of what is to come (Sehling 2, p. 313). The Coburg synod of 1580 advises that the whole history be laid out on Maundy Thursday and Good Friday "in three distinct sermons". **Coburg, *Beschlüsse des coburgischen Synodus*, 1580** (Sehling 1, p. 255):

yet it is held profitable that in villages and towns the whole history of the Passion, on the Thursday and Good Friday, as it came to pass, be expounded to the people briefly and simply in three distinct sermons, that the whole history (as is customary also at the other feasts of the Nativity and Ascension of Christ) the unlearned common people might in such wise the better grasp, learn and retain [it].

11.4.5 Prayer days

Days of repentance. From the 1540s, and above all in time of war, plague and the Turkish threat, the orders appoint **prayer days** (*Bettage*). These were weekly, monthly or occasional, with a sermon of repentance at their centre. **Hesse, *Kirchenordnung*, 1566** (Moderate Reformed; Sehling 8, p. 260):

Therefore with us prayer days are appointed and held on certain fixed days, in which by the sermon the people are brought into knowledge of their sins, exhorted to repentance and faith, and faithfully held to earnest prayer and to the begging off of the punishment, and also to the amendment of their life.

The Palatine orders of the 1590s (Reformed) required attendance at the monthly prayer day on pain of a fine (Sehling 19/2, pp. 777, 780).

The calendar of prayer days is treated in Chapter 12, §12.13.5, and the Litany sung on them in Chapter 13, §13.21.4.

11.4.6 Funeral sermons

Not a eulogy. The funeral sermon (*Leichpredigt*) spread from the 1550s. At Gardelegen in the Mark, the first funeral sermon was held in 1554 (Sehling's introduction, Sehling 3, p. 218). Most orders allow it when the family asks for it. Many keep it short and forbid praise of the dead. **Kurpfalz, *Kirchenordnung*, 1563** (Reformed; Sehling 14, p. 406):

Thereupon shall he do a short sermon or exhortation, and refrain from excessive praise of the departed, that the funeral sermons fall not into abuse.

What to preach, and from what book. At the grave the subject is mortality, sin and death, redemption, the resurrection and eternal life. The Oldenburg order points the pastor to the printed funeral sermons of Johann Spangenberg and Johannes Mathesius. **Oldenburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1573** (Sehling 7/2.1, p. 1109):

the minister shall step forth and of the mortality and weakness of men, of the causes of sin and of death, of the redemption made through Christ, of the resurrection of the dead, of eternal life and the like, do a short sermon and exhortation, as he [may] for this [draw] from the funeral sermons which by old Master Johann Spangenberg, Master Mathesius and others [...]

Half an hour, or none at all. Mecklenburg limits it: "if a funeral sermon is held, it shall not be over half an hour" (*Conformitas ceremoniarum*, c. 1560; Sehling 5, p. 290). The Hohenlohe visitors set the same limit (Sehling 15, p. 427). Some towns abolished funeral sermons altogether, putting the old exhortation and a collect in their place, so that the people would not be kept too long. **Aschersleben, *Kirchen-Agenda* (agreed by the council with the ministers), 1575** (Sehling 2, p. 481):

Thirdly, the funeral sermons shall for all manner of reasons be wholly abolished, and in their stead the old appointed exhortation, [at] a general funeral, [be read] by the pastor at [the burial of] householders or old people, and the collect which is wont to be read before the houses be read at the burial of children and young people, and the blessing spoken thereupon, that the people be not kept too long, and the youth in the school be not neglected.

Several orders refuse a funeral sermon for small children who had not yet come to the Lord's Supper (Sehling 22, p. 480; Sehling 19/1, p. 430).

The burial rites in which the funeral sermon stood are treated in Chapter 13, §13.9.

11.4.7 Wedding sermons

Short and chaste. The wedding sermon (*Hochzeitpredigt*, *Brautpredigt*) was customary in many places and abolished in others. Anhalt allows it where custom has it or it is asked for, but it must be "short, chaste and Christian". **Anhalt, *Kirchenordnung*, 1599** (Reformed; Sehling 2, p. 582):

a short, chaste, Christian wedding sermon (all unspiritual, droll phrases and unseemly proverbs set aside, whereby the chaste ears of the youth may lightly be hurt) [be] held for edification, to which the people shall come sober and attentive.

Aschersleben abolished it in the same article as the funeral sermon. **Aschersleben, *Kirchen-Agenda*, 1575** (Sehling 2, p. 481):

Henceforth all wedding sermons shall be abolished; bride and bridegroom with their bidden guests [shall] go into the church to the marriage only once, on the Monday, and not also on the Sunday, as hath been done hitherto; and so on the Monday the joining and the blessing [shall] be done together, without any sermon.

At Grubenhagen, wedding guests were forbidden to lie "at the drinking, the early soup or the brandy" during the wedding sermon (Sehling 6/2, p. 1065).

The marriage rites in which the wedding sermon stood are treated in Chapter 13, §13.7.

11.5 Texts: what was preached on

11.5.1 The Sunday gospels and epistles kept

Why Luther kept the pericopes. Luther kept the old series of Sunday epistles and gospels (§11.3.2). He gave a practical reason: few preachers can handle a whole evangelist or another book "mightily and profitably". **Luther, *Deutsche Messe und ordnung gottis diensts*, 1526** (Sehling 1, p. 15):

For this also is one of the causes why we keep the epistles and gospels as they stand ordered in the postils: that there are few spiritual preachers who can handle a whole evangelist or other book mightily and profitably.

The Lutheran orders follow him almost without exception. The visitation articles ask whether the pastor preaches "the Sunday gospels" (*dominicalia evangelia*). The Hohenlohe visitors of 1578 charged a pastor with not keeping to the appointed gospels

(Sehling's note, Sehling 15, p. 248). The lessons themselves are treated in Chapter 4 §4.5.

11.5.2 Books in course on weekdays and at Vespers

Lectio continua beside the pericopes. Continuous preaching through a book of the Bible (*lectio continua*) was not given up. It was moved to Vespers and to the weekday sermons. Luther preached the Old Testament "in order" at Sunday Vespers (§11.3.2). The visitors of 1528 wanted "useful and not hard books" for the weekday sermons (§11.3.3). In the towns the weekday preachers worked through whole books. **Rötha, *Kirchen-Ordnung für Rötha*, 1574** (Sehling 1, p. 653):

In the week, on Wednesday early, there is preaching, and the books of holy Scripture are handled as they go one after another, the chief histories, one chapter after another; in Lent, on Sunday at midday and on Wednesday, the Passion is preached.

The Reformed Palatine order of 1563, repeated in 1601, goes further. Sermons are to be taken from the canonical books, and those books expounded which are "most profitable to the common man and most edifying to the church". In 1563 this applied "chiefly on the Sundays" (Sehling 14, p. 557, with the variant noted there). The order thus allows a book in course on Sunday as well as on weekdays.

11.5.3 The chief articles of doctrine through the year

Loci communes. Some orders asked the preacher to cover the chief heads of doctrine (*loci communes*) in the course of a year's Sunday sermons. Pfalz-Veldenz 1574 has this rule (quoted in §11.10.4). The catechism sermon did the same in a smaller compass. Where a sermon was on a feast, the doctrine of the feast was to be taught: the Supper on Maundy Thursday (Mecklenburg c. 1560, Sehling 5, p. 290), and the Passion on Good Friday (§11.4.4).

11.6 How to preach

11.6.1 The shape of a sermon

Prayer, text, summary, doctrines, application, repetition. The orders rarely give a homiletic. Where they describe a sermon, they describe the same shape:

1. an exhortation to prayer, and a prayer or hymn;
2. the reading of the text;
3. a short summary (*summa*) of the text;
4. one, two or three doctrines drawn from it;
5. their application to the hearers;
6. a short repetition at the end;
7. the general prayer.

A village pastor in the county of Henneberg described his own practice in his report to the visitors. **Ritschenhausen, *Gottesdienst-Ordnung*, 1562** (Sehling 2, p. 345):

yet I keep in my sermons commonly this process and order. 1. I exhort the people to prayer; thereafter I [read] out of a book the text of the appointed gospel or history, and show briefly the content, likewise where it belongeth among the parts of Christian doctrine; then I take out of it 1, 2 or 3 doctrines, according to the occasion of the time and the hearers, whereupon I apply the same. Finally I repeat briefly what hath been handled, and so close the sermon with the general prayer for all estates and the present need of the whole of Christendom; and the whole sermon lasteth not over three quarters of an hour.

A Saxon town order describes the same outline, with the propositions repeated at the end "that the hearers may know what they shall carry home with them". **Gottleuba, *Verzeichnus der kirchenordnung zur Gotleuben*, 1567–1577** (Sehling 1, p. 567):

Thereupon followeth the sermon on the gospel, which commonly is not drawn out over an hour; wherein first the sum is shown, thereafter the propositions or themes which one will handle, which are repeated at the end, that the hearers may know what they shall carry home with them. The general prayer. After all sermons prayer is made for the need of the whole worthy Christendom, for all three governments, spiritual, temporal and the household, and also for particular persons who desire and need the common prayer.

Doctrine, terror, comfort, exhortation. The Corvey order of 1603, for the village of Bruchhausen, sets out the same shape. It adds what the sermon is to do to each kind of hearer: the ungodly are to be terrified, the troubled comforted, the careless warned. **Corvey, *Kirchenordnung für das Corveyer Stiftsdorf Bruchhausen*, 1603** (Sehling 21, p. 244):

Next the sermon is begun; wherein, after the pastor hath made from the pulpit a short exhortation to prayer, the whole church with one accord singeth the Our Father, or another customary hymn according to the occasion of the time. After this hymn the text is read, and thereupon followeth a Christian explanation, agreeable to the faith, drawn out of God's Word and confirmed and established therewith; wherein always, as the words read out require, one or more chief parts of Christian doctrine shall be set forth for instruction, finely, orderly and distinctly, as briefly as may be, so that the simple may perceive, grasp and retain it; the rude [and] ungodly shall be terrified with the proclamation of God's wrath; the godly, hearts troubled because of their sins, comforted with the remembrance of God's grace; the secure and careless exhorted; and to every one, as occasion serveth, something set before him for amendment.

11.6.2 Law and gospel, repentance and faith

The content. The visitors of 1528 insisted that repentance be preached with forgiveness (§11.3.3). The later orders put the same thing in the language of law and gospel. **Wurzen, *Gemeine Artikel*, 1542** (Sehling 2, p. 96):

All pastors shall also diligently, before all things, wait upon the doctrine and their pastoral office and cure of souls, and drive the same with all faithful diligence by the preaching of repentance, of the law and the gospel, faith and love, patience, and also the good works commanded of God; without which no cure of souls nor right Christian congregation can stand.

The uses of the sermon. The Hessian order of 1566 (Moderate Reformed) lists the uses of a sermon from 2 Timothy 3:16. It sets the limit of an hour, and it points to the short but weighty sermons of the Fathers. **Hesse, *Kirchenordnung*, 1566** (Moderate Reformed; Sehling 8, p. 242):

But the sermons shall not last over an hour, and shall be directed thereto, that they teach, reprove, correct, exhort, amend, comfort and strengthen. One findeth oft in the books of the holy Fathers short sermons, but very weighty, and such as smite and move the hearts of the hearers and leave behind them a notable reflection.

11.6.3 Plain speech for the common man

Clear words, no bitterness. The orders want the sermon plain enough for the simple to follow. Schleswig-Holstein 1542 puts the method, the length and the manner into one paragraph:

- pray first, read the text, then expound it;
- not more than an hour;
- speak the truth "with clean words, so that he may be understood";
- no abuse and no rebuking anyone by name from the pulpit (§11.9.1).

Schleswig-Holstein, *Kirchenordnung*, 1542 (Sehling 23, p. 91):

He that will preach shall first exhort the people to diligent calling upon the help of God; thereafter read to the people the text which he will expound; lastly also lay it out, [and] not draw out his sermon over an hour long, nor give way to his [own] emotion; only what is the truth, that shall he speak out with clean words, so that he may be understood. In especial shall a preacher refrain from all words of railing and bitterness, and rebuke no one from the pulpit by name; only assail and condemn the vices in general, and what he hath heard for certain. Whereof he hath no knowledge, thereof may he be silent.

Fitted to the hearers. At the end of the century the Reformed Upper Palatine government told its preachers to suit the sermon to the hearers. They were to repeat the foundations "in the simplest way", and to show the hearers how to apply them in repentance and prayer. **Kurpfalz (Upper Palatinate), *Generalanweisung*, 1598** (Reformed; Sehling 13, p. 349):

that they direct themselves in their sermons according to the condition of the hearers, [and] that which serveth to the right foundation of Christian doctrine and to true godliness, the same they [shall] otherwise in the sermons oft and much repeat in the simplest way and well inculcate, and also show how they shall apply the same to themselves in the exercises of repentance and of prayer, and use it godly.

The Palatine class conventions of 1587 (Reformed) asked whether a preacher used "good German" and not "Netherlandish phrases", and whether he spoke slowly enough (§11.11.3).

11.7 Length

11.7.1 An hour on Sunday morning, at most

The common rule. Almost every order that sets a length gives the chief Sunday sermon **one hour at most**. Many give it three quarters. The reason given is always the hearer: the common man cannot attend longer, nor carry more away. **Augsburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1537** (Moderate Reformed; Sehling 12, p. 58):

All these common Sunday sermons also shall not last over an hour; for the common people can in no wise remain attentive longer, and retain what is there handled for [their] amendment.

The Württemberg order of 1536 compares the common man to a sick man, "to whom one must set food often, but little at once". **Württemberg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1536** (Sehling 16, p. 104):

But the sermons also on Sundays and holy days shall not be drawn out over an hour, that the people be not overwhelmed with the muchness and length, and grow weary; since the understanding of the common man can in no wise open itself to grasp so much at once with delight, but [one must] deal with him as it were with a sick man, to whom one must set [things] before him often, but little at once.

The Hohenlohe order of 1578 repeats this sentence almost word for word, and sets the length at "three quarters of an hour, and at the most not over an hour" (Sehling 15, p. 263).

Regensburg gives a reason from memory: long sermons do not edify; "they weaken the memory and make the hearers weary". **Regensburg, *Kirchenregimentsordnung*, 1572** (Sehling 13, p. 510):

Forasmuch as long sermons are not edifying, but weaken the memory and make the hearers weary, the morning sermons on Sundays and holy days shall not be drawn out more than over an hour, but be held an hour at the longest. In the weekday sermons, however, the ministers shall study brevity no less, but rather much more

11.7.2 Half an hour on weekdays and for the catechism

Shorter sermons. The afternoon, weekday, catechism, funeral and wedding sermons are generally held to **half an hour**. The Saxon visitors of 1580 were told to ask about all three limits. **Albertine Saxony, *Ordnung* of Duke August, 1580** (Sehling 1, p. 393):

Whether he preach longer than an hour in the morning on Sundays and holy days. Whether he so order the midday sermon that with singing and all the people be kept no longer than an hour. Whether on the working day he preach over half an hour.

The same order limits the singing before the sermon, so that the hymns do not eat up the hour (Sehling 1, p. 370). Nassau-Weilburg 1576 does the same: at most half an hour of singing before the sermon on holy days, and a quarter on weekdays (Sehling 10, p. 229).

11.7.3 Weather and work

Shorter in the cold. Some orders shorten the sermon for the season. At Obereisenheim the pastor is to start at eight sharp and cut the sermon shorter in winter, so that the poor and the badly clothed young people have no cause to leave the church for the cold. **Castell, *Dorfordnung für Obereisenheim*, 1579** (Sehling 11, p. 689):

The pastor shall also endeavour, when the bells ring together, that he go forthwith into the church, make not the hymns too long, and surely begin to preach at eight o'clock, draw out the sermon not over an hour, and especially in winter time, in the cold, cut it yet shorter; afterwards also lengthen not the prayer and hymns, that the poor man and the youth, who are somewhat ill clad, have no cause by reason of the frost [to run] out of the church [...]

Troppau 1592 gives one hour in summer, three quarters in winter, and half an hour on weekdays (Sehling 3, p. 478). The weekday sermon was set early, or held only in winter, so as not to take the people from their work (§11.4.2).

11.7.4 Overrunning

Complaints. The limits were not always kept. In 1594 the Count of Hohenlohe complained that his pastors preached far beyond the appointed time, "sometimes an hour and a half", to the annoyance of the hearers. **Hohenlohe, *Befehl wegen des Kirchengesangs und der Predigtlänge*, 1594** (Sehling 15, p. 639):

but also that the sermons [have been drawn out] far longer than the time appointed heretofore, and sometimes to an hour and a half

The same command restores the limit of about three quarters of an hour (Sehling 15, p. 640). Visitors were told to ask how long the pastor preached: in Saxony in 1580 (§11.7.2), and in Hohenlohe in 1587, "how long, roughly, he letteth his sermon last" (Sehling 15, p. 532).

11.7.5 The limits in the orders

The table gives the limits found, by order. "Sun." is the chief Sunday or holy-day morning sermon; "afternoon" covers the midday, Vespers and catechism sermons.

Order	Sehling	Sun.	Afternoon	Weekday	Other
Augsburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1537 (Moderate Reformed)	12, p. 58	≤ 1 h			
Württemberg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1536	16, p. 104	≤ 1 h			
Schleswig-Holstein, *Kirchenordnung*, 1542	23, p. 91	≤ 1 h			
Zwickau, *Verordnung der Visitatoren*, 1556	1, p. 726			early sermon ≤ ½ h	
Mecklenburg, *Conformitas ceremoniarum*, c. 1560	5, p. 290				funeral ≤ ½ h
Regensburg, *Ordnung für die Geistlichen zur Pestzeit*, 1562	13, p. 435	about ½ h (plague time)		about ½ h	
Ritschenhausen, *Gottesdienst-Ordnung*, 1562	2, p. 345	≤ ¾ h			
Hesse, *Kirchenordnung*, 1566 (Moderate Reformed)	8, p. 242	≤ 1 h			
Gottleuba, 1567–1577	1, p. 567	about 1 h			
Prussia, *Kirchenordnung und ceremonien*, 1568	4, p. 74			catechism sermons ≤ ½ h	
Regensburg, *Kirchenregimentsordnung*, 1572	13, p. 510	≤ 1 h		shorter still	
Pfalz-Veldenz, *Kirchenordnung*, 1574	18, p. 522	≤ 1 h			
Nassau-Weilburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1576	10, pp. 229, 232, 235	¾ h, at most 1 h	catechism ≤ ½ h		singing before the sermon ≤ ½ h (holy days), ≤ ¼ h (weekdays)

Order	Sehling	Sun.	Afternoon	Weekday	Other
Pfalz-Neuburg, *Generalartikel*, 1576	13, p. 197				wedding and funeral about ½ h
Strasbourg, *Gottesdienstordnung*, 1577	20/1, p. 518				funeral ≤ ½ h
Hohenlohe, *Kirchenordnung*, 1578	15, p. 263	¾ h, at most 1 h			
Castell, *Dorfordnung für Obereisenheim*, 1579	11, p. 689	≤ 1 h, shorter in winter			
Albertine Saxony, *Ordnung* of Duke August, 1580	1, p. 393	≤ 1 h	≤ 1 h with the singing	≤ ½ h	
Sponheim (Hintere Grafschaft), *Kirchen- und Zensurordnung*, 1590	18, p. 652	¾ h	½ h	½ h	
Ysenburg-Ronneburg, *Kirchenzuchtordnung*, 1591 (Reformed)	10, p. 595	≤ 1 h	½ h	½ h	
Troppau (Freudenthal and Goldstein), *Kirchenordnungen*, 1592	3, p. 478	≤ 1 h summer, ≤ ¾ h winter		≤ ½ h	
Hohenlohe, *Befehl wegen … der Predigtlänge*, 1594	15, pp. 639–640	about ¾ h			
Ysenburg-Birstein, *Kirchenordnung*, 1598 (Reformed)	10, p. 655	neither under nor over 1 h	¾ h	¾ h	
Baden, *Kirchenordnungsmandat*, 1601	16, p. 552		catechism ½ h		
Kurpfalz, *Kirchenordnung*, 1601 (Reformed)	14, p. 558	≤ 1 h	≤ 1 h	≤ 1 h	
Corvey (Bruchhausen), *Kirchenordnung*, 1603	21, p. 244	"as briefly as may be"			

11.8 Postils and preparation

11.8.1 Reading a postil from the pulpit

Luther's advice. A postil was a printed collection of sermons on the Sunday epistles and gospels. Luther thought it would be best to read his postil to the people. This was not only for the sake of preachers who "could do no better". It was also a guard against enthusiasts and sects, lest everyone preach what he likes, "of blue ducks" instead of the gospel. **Luther, *Deutsche Messe und ordnung gottis diensts*, 1526** (Sehling 1, pp. 14–15):

And it seemeth to me, if one had the German postil complete through the year, it were the best that it be ordained to read to the people the postil of the day, whole or a piece out of the book; not only for the sake of the preachers who could do no better, but also to guard against the enthusiasts and sects; as one seeth and perceiveth from the homilies at Matins, that such also was once the manner. Otherwise, where spiritual understanding and the Spirit himself speaketh not through the preachers (to whom I will not hereby set a bound; the Spirit teacheth better to speak than all postils and homilies), it cometh at last to this, that every one will preach what he will, and instead of the gospel and its exposition there will again be preaching of blue ducks.

Village pastors. The Albertine orders of 1545 apply this to the poor village pastors. Until they can preach "out of their own understanding", they are to read from the pulpit Corvinus's postil or Luther's *Hauspostille*. **Albertine Saxony, *Die Cellischen Ordnungen*, 1545** (Sehling 1, p. 297):

But where in the villages poor simple pastors were not able to do this, lest they preach out of their own head, their own conceit, or otherwise anything erroneous, they shall take before them Corvinus's postil or Luther's house postil, and on the Sunday read out of it to the people from the pulpit the exposition of the gospel, until through long practice they also might at length come so far that they could make a Christian sermon out of their own understanding.

Many orders required every parish to own Luther's postils with the Bible and the catechisms. In the Brandenburg villages the pastor had to own the Bible, the *Hauspostille*, the catechisms and the church order (Sehling 3, pp. 153, 204).

11.8.2 Against preaching from postils

Borrowed feathers. By the second half of the century the complaint is the opposite. Young men pass the examination by learning answers by heart, have read little of the Bible, and then "betake themselves to postils, adorn themselves with strange feathers". **Albertine Saxony, *Ordnung* of Duke August, 1580** (Sehling 1, p. 377):

that the young students who purpose to betake themselves to the preaching office oftentimes have not only learned such examinations word for word by heart with great want of understanding, and, when they are asked in other words, can answer nothing at all, but also have many times read nothing whatever in the Old and New Testament; who afterwards betake themselves to postils, adorn themselves with strange feathers, and have little art or skill of their own wherewith they should serve the church.

Write your sermons. Nassau-Dillenburg orders its pastors to study the Bible and to write all their sermons out, not to take them "without understanding" from the printed postils. **Nassau-Dillenburg, *Visitationsabschied*, 1570** (Sehling 10, p. 110):

The pastors also shall be held by the special superintendents to diligent reading and studying in the Bible, that they also write all their sermons, and draw and take them not without understanding here and there out of the published and printed postils, but rather out of God's word and the holy Scripture of the prophets and apostles itself.

Use them, but do not lean on them. The middle way is put most clearly in the lordship of Wolfstein. The pastor is to use "pure postils", which are named, but not rely on them wholly: they were published "not to make lazy pastors". **Wolfstein, *Christliche Instructio des Thomas Stieber*, 1574** (Sehling 13, p. 569):

and in such sermon make use of pure postils, as Luther's, Philip's, Brenz's, Spangenberg's, Mathesius's and [those] of other godly teachers. Yet shall the pastors not rely wholly and altogether only on the postils, but shall also study themselves; as indeed such postils were not published for this, that they should make lazy pastors, but that the preachers and pastors should learn out of them how they shall set forth the doctrine of God's word and use it among their hearers.

The Palatine visitation articles of 1594 (Reformed) ask "out of what writings and commentaries" the ministers draw and gather their sermons (Sehling 19/2, p. 822).

11.8.3 Meditation and writing

Not into the pulpit unprepared. Late orders expect a written sermon, or at least a written outline. In Sponheim an old pastor who could not write out every sermon might keep to a written disposition of its parts. He was to show it at the ministers' conventions, to prove "that he hath not gone up into the pulpit without foregoing meditation". **Sponheim (Hintere Grafschaft), *Generalartikel*, 1608** (Sehling 18, p. 672):

Yet it is left to the discretion of the said inspectors, whether a preacher, perchance by reason of great age, had his hindrance, that he could not compose all [his] sermons, [that] the same be left at a written disposition of the parts, which he hath to lay before the conventions, and therewith to prove that he hath not gone up into the pulpit without foregoing meditation.

Assum's method. Sehling's notes to the Hohenlohe questions of 1587 summarize the advice of the court preacher Johann Assum. The pastor is to pray, read the text diligently, and make his own thoughts on it: its argument, its division, parallels and examples from other parts of Scripture. He is then to write it out "as if he were the very first writer on the Bible", and only then read postils and amend his draft (editor's note, Sehling 15, p. 532).

11.9 Rebuke, polemic and the limits of the pulpit

11.9.1 Rebuke the vices, name no one

The office of rebuke. No order takes rebuke out of the sermon. The preacher is to rebuke sin openly; the Saxon order of 1580 calls this his *Strafamt* (§11.9.2). But he is to rebuke vices "in general" and leave persons unnamed. Private sinners are to be dealt with privately, following Matthew 18. **Merseburg, *Was den pfarhern auf itztkünftigen synodo (1545) solle angezeigt werden*** (Sehling 2, p. 26):

and on the other hand exhort to Christian good works and conversation, and also rebuke the vices in general by the holy Scripture and its examples, but attack no one specifically, nor take it upon themselves to put [any] under the ban, and refrain from reviling and unseemly railing in the pulpit and elsewhere.

An Augsburg preacher's contract of 1535 (Moderate Reformed) has him swear to rebuke "gently and modestly", "but neither with naming nor with pointing at particular persons". **Augsburg, *Bestallung eines Predigers*, 1535** (Moderate Reformed; Sehling 12, p. 46):

[and] besides touch upon the evil as need requireth, as becometh a faithful Christian preacher, rebuke gently and modestly, and from the pulpit exhort every one in common, but neither with naming nor with pointing at particular persons, away from all false worship, vices and sins, to the honour and also the true service of God and all laudable virtues, as is meet

The Schleswig-Holstein order of 1542 says the same, and adds: "whereof he hath no knowledge, thereof may he be silent" (§11.6.3).

When names were spoken. The pulpit was used for names, but by order and not by the preacher's choice:

- **Excommunication.** Where the steps of Matthew 18 had failed, the consistory's sentence was read from the pulpit, with the name. **Mecklenburg, *Consistorialordnung*, 1570** (Sehling 5, p. 245):

they shall in the church or parish wherein they dwell, by a public sentence of the consistory, be proclaimed by name from the pulpit into the ban, and be thrust out of the communion of saints.

- **Banns of marriage.** Couples were "proclaimed" from the pulpit, with their parents and masters if they were strangers (§11.10.4).

11.9.2 No private grudges in the pulpit

The visitors' questions. The Saxon order of 1580 has the visitors ask how the pastor shows himself "in his office of rebuke". Does he rebuke with Christian gentleness, or "out of private affection and revenge" bring his own affairs into the pulpit and name people? **Albertine Saxony, *Ordnung* of Duke August, 1580** (Sehling 1, p. 394):

How the pastor (or in towns also other ministers) showeth himself in his office of rebuke: whether he rebuke with Christian gentleness and good discretion, or out of private affection and revenge bring his own affairs into the pulpit, name the people, or otherwise, unnamed yet painted out, make them out evil, let himself be moved to anger, [use] sharp, unseemly, stinging, reviling, coarse words and gestures in the sermons.

Later in the same order the visitors are told that the rule against preaching against persons concerns only these "offensive sermons". It does not forbid rebuke itself (Sehling 1, p. 422).

11.9.3 Disputations belong in the schools

Controversy in the pulpit. The doctrinal quarrels of the 1550s to 1580s produced a series of mandates against "railing and condemning" from the pulpit. The Ansbach margrave told his clergy that disputations belong "in the universities, and not in the churches in the pulpit". **Brandenburg-Ansbach-Kulmbach, *Begleitschreiben zur Konkordie von 1570*** (Sehling 11, p. 377):

that, in consideration of their office and of the present state and assault of the church, they refrain wholly in the pulpit from all offensive disputing. For the disputations belong in the universities and not in the churches in the pulpit (where only what

buildeth up should be taught, but what breaketh down and offendeth should be avoided); as indeed, even without that, nothing is set forth so simply that it be not drawn by some into misunderstanding.

Princes against condemnation. The princes of the Lower Saxon Circle, meeting at Lüneburg in 1562, forbade "unseemly railing and reviling in the pulpit". They also forbade the condemnation of others "who have not yet been heard nor ever convicted", on pain of banishment. **Lower Saxon Circle, *Abschied des Lüneburger Kreistages*, 1562** (Sehling 23, p. 177):

Whereas then the unseemly railing and reviling in the pulpit, and also the condemning of other people who have not yet been heard nor ever convicted, becometh not godly and Christian preachers, and such an undertaking is not only against God's command and Christian love, but rather great hostility and mistrust between high and low persons, and also contempt of all religion, ariseth thereby

The same year the Bremen council (Philippist) forbade railing in the pulpit and bound preaching to Scripture and the Augsburg Confession (Sehling 7/2.2, p. 540). Johann Casimir's Reformed government in the Palatinate issued a mandate "against condemnations" in 1584 (Sehling 14, p. 512). In 1609 Duke Johann Adolf of Gottorf forbade "unedifying school questions" in sermons, on pain of loss of office (Sehling's introduction, Sehling 23, pp. 323–324). The Upper Palatine *Generalanweisung* of 1598 (Reformed; §11.6.3) begins its rule on plain preaching with the same complaint: preachers who angered themselves "in so holy a place" over matters of the schools.

No politics. Some orders also kept the preacher out of the business of the magistrate. The Colmar preachers' oaths of 1575, 1590 and 1615 forbade reviling anyone in the pulpit for their views on disputed questions. They also bade the preachers abstain from "political matters and administrations" and not disparage the council (Sehling's introduction, Sehling 20/2, p. 479).

11.10 Around the sermon: prayer, greeting, confession, intercession and notices

11.10.1 The medieval pulpit office

What the reformers inherited. Sehling's editor sets out the background in a note to an early East Frisian order, Norden's of 1528 (Reformed). Long before the Reformation the preacher said a group of vernacular pieces from the pulpit, mostly after the sermon:

- intercessions, or bidding to intercession;
- the Lord's Prayer and the Creed;
- in many places the open confession (*Offene Schuld*) with absolution;
- from the thirteenth century also the Ten Commandments and the *Ave Maria*;
- "interjections and announcements".

The orders of the Reformation kept this group around the sermon. They dropped the *Ave Maria* and turned the rest into the prayer before the sermon and the confession, general prayer and notices after it (editor's note, Sehling 7/1, p. 431).

11.10.2 The prayer before the sermon

An exhortation to pray, and a hymn or the Our Father. The preacher goes up, exhorts the people to pray for the Holy Spirit and for the fruit of the Word, and a prayer follows. Often it is the Lord's Prayer, said or sung, or the hymn "Nun bitten wir den heiligen Geist" (Now pray we the Holy Ghost; see Chapter 8 §8.10.1). At Nördlingen the first stanza of "Nun bitten" (Now pray we the Holy Ghost) opened the sermon with the Lord's Prayer. **Nördlingen, *Ordnung der ceremonien in der pfarkirchen zu Sant Georgen* (Caspar Löner), 1544** (Sehling 12, p. 319; dated 1555 in the running head):

"Now pray we the Holy Ghost", the first stanza, to be begun in the pulpit, with the Our Father, at the beginning of the sermon, which shall always be made out of the gospel of the Sunday or of the holy day.

In Kurland the preacher might intone the Lord's Prayer from the pulpit and let the whole congregation sing it, "as is customary in many evangelical churches of the German nation". **Kurland, *Kurländische Kirchenordnung*, 1570** (Sehling 5, p. 92):

Where one will also sometimes intone the text of the Our Father before the sermon in the pulpit, and let the whole congregation sing it, as is otherwise customary in many evangelical churches of the German nation

11.10.3 The greeting

The apostolic greeting. The Palatine order of 1601 (Reformed) prescribes a fixed opening for every sermon: the apostolic greeting, in one of two forms. **Kurpfalz, *Kirchenordnung*, 1601** (Reformed; Sehling 14, p. 558):

The common entrance of all sermons. Grace, peace and mercy from God the Father and his beloved Son Jesus Christ our Lord, together with the communion of the Holy Ghost, be with us all. Amen. Or thus: The grace of our Lord Jesus Christ, and the love of God, and the communion of the Holy Ghost, be with you all. Amen. 2 Corinthians 13, verse 13.

11.10.4 After the sermon: confession, intercession and notices

The order of the pulpit. In many southern and western orders the sermon is followed, still in the pulpit, by:

1. an exhortation to prayer;
2. the open confession of sins and the absolution or "comfort";
3. the general prayer, with particular intercessions for the sick, for those in trouble and for newly married couples;
4. the notices: banns, feasts of the coming week, alms.

Pfalz-Veldenz, *Kirchenordnung*, 1574 (Sehling 18, p. 522):

When the hymn is ended the pastor goeth up into the pulpit, beginneth the sermon with prayer, then readeth the text of the gospel, and explaineth it according to his gift and the condition of the hearers, yet not over an hour. And the pastors shall endeavour to explain to the people, properly and understandably, out of the divine Scripture, the chief *loci communes* in the Sunday sermons through the year. After the sermon (because then the number of the people is greatest) he exhorteth to the common prayer, maketh the public common confession of sins together with the comfort and forgiveness of sins, as is set down before, folio […]. Thereafter he recounteth all manner of present need for which it is needful to pray, likewise when there are newly married folk, or [when there is need] to pray for the sick [and] troubled persons

Note the reason given for placing the confession and prayer **after** the sermon: "because then the number of the people is greatest". Many came late, after the opening hymns and lessons.

At Corvey the sermon is followed in the pulpit by the exhortation to the communicants, the confession and absolution, and the general prayer. Banns and other notices "may be done in this place". **Corvey, *Kirchenordnung für das Corveyer Stiftsdorf Bruchhausen*, 1603** (Sehling 21, p. 244):

9. When the sermon is closed, a short reminder and exhortation to the communicants is made. 10. Thereupon followeth the confession, shrift and acknowledgement of sins, and the absolution, release or loosing from sins, in such manner as they are written hereafter. 11. Finally [it] is closed with the customary prayer for the need of all estates or of the whole of Christendom; and these pieces are all performed upon the pulpit; and if perchance persons who have betrothed themselves in marriage were to be called, or anything else to be shown and proclaimed in common, that might be done in this place.

A prayer of repentance from the pulpit. Schaumburg ordered a set prayer of repentance and forgiveness to be recited from the pulpit after the main Sunday sermon. It was not meant to replace private confession. **Schaumburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1614** (Sehling 7/2.2, p. 117):

And although we have ordained a Christian prayer of repentance and forgiveness of sin, as shall follow, which our pastors in the whole land shall recite publicly from the pulpit every Sunday after the high forenoon sermon is held, yet shall the same in no wise be meant for the abolishing of the aforesaid most profitable private confession

Banns from the pulpit. Prussia requires the pastor to name strangers' parents, masters and homes in the banns "from the pulpit", so that any impediment may come to light. **Prussia, *Kirchen ordnung und ceremonien*, 1568** (Sehling 4, p. 93):

where the persons were unknown, as commonly the servants are, the pastor shall name not only their names and surnames, but also their parents, country and the masters with whom they serve, and make them known particularly in the announcement from the pulpit.

The texts of the general prayers said from the pulpit are given family by family in Chapter 6. The hymns sung after the sermon ("Erhalt uns, Herr, bei deinem Wort" and others) are in Chapter 8 §8.11.

11.11 Preachers: trial sermons, practice and censure

11.11.1 Who preached

Pastor, deacons, chaplains. In the towns the preaching was shared out by the order. The pastor took the chief Sunday sermon; the deacons or chaplains took the early, afternoon, weekday and hospital sermons (§11.4.1, §11.4.2). Funeral and wedding sermons often went by turn, or to whichever minister the family asked for (Sehling 3, pp. 218, 290). The village pastor preached everything himself. Schoolmasters and students did not preach in the orders' regular services. The question of who might preach at all, and on whose call, belongs to ordination and is outside this chapter; see Chapter 16 §16.5.1 for the deacons.

11.11.2 The trial sermon

Examination, then a trial sermon. From mid-century a candidate for a parish was examined in doctrine and then had to preach a **trial sermon** (*Probpredigt*). It showed whether he could teach, exhort and comfort out of Scripture, and how he spoke. **Kurpfalz, *Kirchenratsordnung*, 1564** (Reformed; Sehling 14, p. 412):

After the examination, if the examinee hath answered well, a trial sermon also shall be laid upon him to do, from which our church councillors may see and gather how he can teach the common people out of the Scripture, exhort [them] to amendment and comfort [them]; and from all the circumstances, likewise from the utterance and the intelligible German speech and action, may the better judge what place is to be committed to him. And the faults that are found in him shall be told him in a friendly manner, and he be exhorted to amend them.

In Osnabrück the order of steps was: the testimonial of the call shown to the superintendent; examination by the ministers; a trial sermon in St Mary's; and then ordination with the laying on of hands "after the form which Doctor Martin Luther set" (*Agende* of 1588, as printed 1618; Sehling 7/1, p. 287). The trial sermon appears in the same way in Saxony 1580 (Sehling 1, p. 380), Pfalz-Neuburg 1576 (Sehling 13, p. 172), Wolfstein 1574 (Sehling 13, p. 567) and the Calenberg-Göttingen visitation instruction of 1588 (Sehling 6/2, p. 883).

The examination and trial sermon before ordination are treated in Chapter 15, §15.7.3.

11.11.3 Practice sermons and censure

Practice for pastors already in office. In Albertine Saxony the superintendents were to have the town and country clergy preach in turn on weekdays in the towns. They set them texts from the Psalms or Paul some days in advance, and repeated the exercise according to each man's diligence. **Albertine Saxony, *Visitations-Instruktion von 1577*** (Sehling 1, p. 349):

That the pastors and deacons in the country and in the towns also be stirred to study and diligence, our superintendents and adjuncts shall let them preach in order in the towns in the week, give them some days before matters out of the Psalms, the Epistles of Paul or otherwise out of the Bible, to preach upon; and thereafter, as each man's diligence or negligence is found, repeat such exercise.

Ansbach made the same rule for its chapters in 1565 (Sehling 11, p. 350).

A sermon criticized by colleagues. The Palatine classical conventions of 1587 (Reformed) made such criticism systematic. At each convention one minister preached. He then withdrew, and the others were asked in turn what faults they had found and how they might be amended. The order gives a checklist for the critics. **Kurpfalz, *Ordnung der Classicalconvente*, 1587** (Reformed; Sehling 14, p. 530):

Hereupon the minister who hath held the sermon shall be bidden to withdraw, and the others asked and heard one after another, what faults they [find] in the sermon of him that hath withdrawn, and how it is to be amended. Here shall all be examined that belongeth to right and edifying sermons, as for example: whether he be too long-winded therein, and whether it be fitted [to the hearers]; whether he hath rightly divided the text; whether he attaineth the scope of the text, or otherwise treateth strange questions which are not properly taken out of the text; whether he rightly pursueth the parts which he proposed to treat; whether he, by staying so long on one part of the sermon, may not carry out the others as promised; whether he also set forth the matters slowly, deliberately and understandably to the common man for edification, and throw not the words

hastily one upon another; whether he also use good German chiefly, and not Netherlandish phrases; whether he propound all with a Christian zeal, that every one may perceive his earnestness [and] he may stir up himself and his hearers

The list continues with whether he brought private matters into the pulpit. The "Netherlandish phrases" probably reflect the ministers from the Netherlands then serving in the Reformed Palatinate. Hanau-Münzenberg (1600, Reformed) summoned the country preachers in turn, the youngest first, every fortnight or month, to preach the weekday sermon. Afterwards the consistory told each one what was lacking in his sermon "in matters of form and of doctrine" (Sehling 10, p. 536).

11.12 Hearers

11.12.1 Attendance

A duty, enforced. The orders treat hearing the sermon as a duty of every household. It was enforced by the parish officers and by fines. Late in the century the weekday sermons in particular were poorly attended (§11.4.2). The Ysenburg counts required at least one person from every house at every weekday sermon. The mayor (*Schultheiß*) and the church wardens counted the people after the sermon and fined those absent. **Ysenburg-Birstein, *Kirchenzuchtordnung*, 1588** (Sehling 10, p. 638):

At all weekday sermons also at the least one person out of every house shall appear; whereto the mayor and the church wardens shall give good heed, have [the people] counted after the sermon is held, and bring those who stay away to the due penalty indicated above

Church attendance as a duty of the laity is treated in Chapter 15, §15.8.1, and the enforcement of rest on holy days in Chapter 12, §12.11.2.

11.12.2 Taverns, markets and games during the sermon

The first visitations. The first Saxon visitors already found people walking in the market and round the church during the sermon, and going off to the beer houses and the brandy. **Ernestine Saxony, *Verordnungen aus der Visitation von 1528*, 1529** (Sehling 1, p. 177):

Further it cometh before his Electoral Grace that the subjects in part hear the word of God negligently, walk on the market and about the church, and so give offence and occasion thereto to others also; also some of them go during the sermon into the beer houses and to the burnt wine; on these heed shall be given

Innkeepers forbidden to serve. The remedy was to shut the inns for the length of the sermon. **Ernestine Saxony, *Pollizei und landsordnung* of the dukes Johann Friedrich the Middle, Johann Wilhelm and Johann Friedrich the Younger, 1556** (Sehling 1, p. 229):

That those also who are wont to frequent the wine or beer taverns during the sermons may have the less occasion thereto, we will that henceforth every one that poureth wine or beer set no guests, nor let [them] be set, during the sermon and so long as it lasteth, be it before or after noon.

The same rules recur through the century: no shops open, no trading, no games, no dancing and no labour service (*Fron*) during the sermon. The Albertine articles of 1557 tell the pastor to rebuke such disorders from the pulpit, and the judges to fine the offenders (Sehling 1, p. 325). A Palatine mandate of 1592 (Reformed) complains that labour service was called out on holy days and prayer days and during the weekday sermon (Sehling 19/2, p. 785).

11.12.3 Chattering, sleeping, leaving early

Fines in the church. The Ysenburg-Ronneburg discipline order of 1591 (Reformed) fines those who chatter or sleep during the sermon, leave before it ends, or come late. It sets the length of the sermon in the same breath. **Ysenburg-Ronneburg, *Kirchenzuchtordnung*, 1591** (Reformed; Sehling 10, p. 595):

If any one chatter or sleep during the sermon, or abide not to the end in the sermon (which on Sunday in the morning shall last not over an hour, but in the afternoon and at the weekday sermon half an hour), unless bodily weakness or other weighty causes be present, or appear not at the right time when the ringing is ended, he shall pay six shillings on Sunday and four shillings for the weekday sermon.

Stay to the end. Leaving after the sermon, before the Supper and the prayers, was a common complaint. The orders tell the preachers to exhort the people often to stay until the whole service is done. **Augsburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1537** (Moderate Reformed; Sehling 12, p. 58):

Of exhortation to the people that they remain with the congregation to the end. And the preachers shall with all diligence oft exhort the people that they remain together until the prayer, the singing and the holy sacrament be wholly performed; with faithful reminder how unchristian it is not to call upon the Lord, in all devotion, with the other Christians and the whole church, for the common need

Corvey 1603 gives the same charge (Sehling 21, pp. 244–245). Pfalz-Veldenz moved the confession and general prayer to after the sermon "because then the number of the people is greatest" (§11.10.4). That shows the reverse problem: many people came only for the sermon.

11.13 Table by order

Key.

- **Sunday**: the sermons of a Sunday or holy day, and their texts.
- **Week**: the weekday sermons.
- **Length**: the limit for the chief sermon; other limits in the Notes.
- **?**: not stated in the passages read.

Order	Vol.	Sunday	Week	Length	Notes
Luther, *Von ordenung gottis diensts*, 1523	1	Mass and Vespers, each with a sermon	daily lesson and exposition, morning and evening	?	no gathering without the Word
Luther, *Deutsche Messe*, 1526	1	early: epistle; Mass: gospel; Vespers: OT in course	?	Passion: an hour a day	pericopes kept; postil may be read
Unterricht der Visitatoren, 1528	1	morning gospel; afternoon catechism	Wednesday and Friday	?	repentance with faith
Schlieben, 1529	1	?	Thursday, not midsummer or midwinter	?	catechism through the year
Reutlingen, c. 1531	17/2	?	villages: weekly in winter	?	catechism four times a year
Wittenberg, 1533	1	?	Monday, Tuesday, Thursday, Friday	?	
Augsburg, 1535–1537 (Moderate Reformed)	12	?	?	≤ 1 h	no names in rebuke; stay to the end
Württemberg, 1536	16	?	?	≤ 1 h	the common man as a sick man
Schleswig-Holstein, 1542	23	?	?	≤ 1 h	prayer, text, exposition; no names
Wurzen, 1542	2	?	?	?	repentance, law and gospel

Order	Vol.	Sunday	Week	Length	Notes
Nördlingen, 1544	12	gospel	?	?	"Nun bitten" (Now pray we the Holy Ghost) and Our Father before the sermon
Merseburg, 1545	2	?	?	?	vices *in genere* (in general)
Albertine Saxony, *Cellische Ordnungen*, 1545	1	?	?	?	village pastors read Corvinus or the *Hauspostille*
Zwickau, 1556	1	?	early sermon Tuesday, Friday, Saturday	early sermon ≤ ½ h	for servants and craftsmen
Albertine Saxony, *General-Artikel*, 1557	1	morning gospel; afternoon catechism	once	?	epistle moved to weekday in farming places
Mecklenburg, *Conformitas*, c. 1560	5	?	?	?	funeral ≤ ½ h
Lower Saxon Circle, 1562; Bremen, 1562 (Philippist)	23; 7/2.2	?	?	?	against railing and condemning
Ritschenhausen, 1562	2	festivals and Sundays	Wednesday and Friday	≤ ¾ h	prayer, text, summary, doctrines, application, repetition
Kurpfalz, 1563–1564 (Reformed)	14	?	?	?	funeral: no praise; trial sermon
Hesse, 1566 (Moderate Reformed)	8	?	?	≤ 1 h	teach, reprove, comfort; prayer days
Gottleuba, 1567–1577	1	gospel	Wednesday	about 1 h	summary, propositions, repetition
Prussia, 1568	4	?	catechism sermons	catechism ≤ ½ h	banns from the pulpit
Ansbach, 1570	11	?	?	?	disputations belong in the schools
Nassau-Dillenburg, 1570	10	?	?	?	sermons to be written, not taken from postils
Regensburg, 1572	13	morning sermon	weekday sermons	≤ 1 h	weekday shorter still
Oldenburg, 1573	7/2.1	?	?	?	funeral sermon from Spangenberg and Mathesius
Pfalz-Veldenz, 1574	18	gospel; *loci communes* through the year	?	≤ 1 h	confession and prayer after the sermon
Wolfstein, 1574	13	early sermon	Friday	?	pure postils, but study too

Order	Vol.	Sunday	Week	Length	Notes
Rötha, 1574	1	morning gospel twice; afternoon catechism	Wednesday: books in course	?	Passion in Lent
Torgau, 1575	1	early sermon: gospel	Thursday: catechism	?	Small Catechism every quarter
Aschersleben, 1575	2	?	?	?	funeral and wedding sermons abolished
Nassau-Weilburg, 1576	10	?	?	¾ h, at most 1 h	catechism ≤ ½ h; singing limited
Pfalz-Neuburg, 1576	13	?	?	?	wedding and funeral ½ h; trial sermon
Hohenlohe, 1578	15	appointed gospels	?	¾ h, at most 1 h	Württemberg wording
Castell (Obereisenheim), 1579	11	begins at 8	?	≤ 1 h	shorter in winter
Albertine Saxony, 1580	1	?	?	≤ 1 h; weekday ≤ ½ h	postils and "strange feathers"; private grudges
Coburg synod, 1580	1	?	?	?	Passion in three sermons
Henneberg, 1582	2	?	Wednesday	?	six Passion sermons in Lent
Kurpfalz, *Classicalconvente*, 1587 (Reformed)	14	?	Thursday or Friday at the convention	?	sermon censured by colleagues
Ysenburg-Birstein, 1588	10	?	one person from each house	?	counted after the sermon
Sponheim, 1590	18	early ¾ h	½ h	¾ h	
Ysenburg-Ronneburg, 1591 (Reformed)	10	?	?	≤ 1 h; afternoon and weekday ½ h	fines for chatter, sleep, leaving
Troppau, 1592	3	?	?	1 h summer, ¾ h winter	weekday ½ h
Hohenlohe, 1594	15	?	?	about ¾ h	complaint of 1½ h
Ysenburg-Birstein, 1598 (Reformed)	10	early: gospel; afternoon: catechism	Wednesday early	1 h	¾ h otherwise
Kurpfalz (Upper Palatinate), 1598 (Reformed)	13	?	?	?	fitted to the hearers; no school quarrels
Anhalt, 1599 (Reformed)	2	?	?	?	wedding sermon short and chaste

Order	Vol.	Sunday	Week	Length	Notes
Kurpfalz, 1601 (Reformed)	14	at 8	?	≤ 1 h	apostolic greeting; prayer-day sermons
Corvey (Bruchhausen), 1603	21	sermon in the Mass	?	"as briefly as may be"	doctrine, terror, comfort; pulpit acts
Sponheim, 1608	18	?	?	?	written sermon or outline
Schaumburg, 1614	7/2.2	?	?	?	prayer of repentance from the pulpit

11.14 Concordance of the orders quoted

Every order quoted or cited in this chapter is listed below by region. The table gives:

- **Sehling**: the volume and pages in Sehling's edition.
- **Doc**: the `eko.db` document that holds the text, for full-text lookup. A single database record may hold several orders.
- **§**: the sections where the order is quoted or cited.

Saxony, Thuringia and central Germany

Order	Sehling	Doc	§
Luther, *Von ordenung gottis diensts in der gemeine*, 1523	1, p. 2	2	11.3.1
Luther, *Deutsche Messe und ordnung gottis diensts*, 1526	1, pp. 13–16	3	11.3.2, 11.4.4, 11.5.1, 11.8.1
Ernestine Saxony, *Unterricht der visitatoren an die pfarrherrn*, 1528	1, pp. 152, 168	9	11.3.3
Ernestine Saxony, *Verordnungen aus der Visitation von 1528*, 1529	1, p. 177	11	11.12.2
Schlieben, *Kirchen-Ordnung für die Stadt Schlieben*, 1529	1, p. 659	129	11.4.2
Wittenberg, *Kirchen-Ordnung für die Stadt Wittenberg*, 1533	1, p. 701	148	11.4.1
Wurzen, *Gemeine Artikel*, 1542	2, p. 96	1223	11.6.2
Merseburg, *Was den pfarhern auf itztkünftigen synodo (1545) solle angezeigt werden*	2, p. 26	1212	11.9.1
Albertine Saxony, *Die Cellischen Ordnungen*, 1545	1, p. 297	33	11.8.1
Ernestine Saxony, *Pollizei und landsordnung*, 1556	1, p. 229	22	11.12.2
Zwickau, *Verordnung der Visitatoren*, 1556	1, p. 726	155	11.4.2, 11.7.5
Albertine Saxony, *General-Artikel und gemeiner Bericht*, 1557	1, pp. 323, 325	37	11.4.1, 11.12.2
Ritschenhausen (Henneberg), *Gottesdienst-Ordnung*, 1562	2, p. 345	1249	11.6.1, 11.7.5
Gottleuba, *Verzeichnus der kirchenordnung zur Gotleuben*, 1567–1577	1, p. 567	87	11.6.1, 11.7.5
Rötha, *Kirchen-Ordnung für Rötha*, 1574	1, p. 653	125	11.5.2
Torgau, *Verordnung der Visitatoren von 1575*	1, p. 683	141	11.4.3
Aschersleben, *Kirchen-Agenda*, 1575	2, p. 481	1260	11.4.6, 11.4.7

Order	Sehling	Doc	§
Albertine Saxony, *Visitations-Instruktion von 1577*	1, p. 349	40	11.11.3
Coburg, *Beschlüsse des coburgischen Synodus*, 1580	1, p. 255	26	11.4.4
Albertine Saxony, *Ordnung* of Duke August, 1580	1, pp. 370, 377, 380, 393, 394, 422	44	11.7.2, 11.7.4, 11.7.5, 11.8.2, 11.9.2, 11.11.2
Henneberg, *Kirchen ordnung* of Georg Ernst, 1582	2, p. 313	1247	11.4.4
Anhalt, *Kirchenordnung*, 1599 (Reformed)	2, p. 582	1263	11.4.7

Franconia, Swabia, Alsace and the Palatinates

Order	Sehling	Doc	§
Reutlingen, *Kirchenordnung*, c. 1531	17/2, p. 42	827	11.4.2, 11.4.3
Augsburg, *Bestallung eines Predigers*, 1535 (Moderate Reformed)	12, p. 46	336	11.9.1
Württemberg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1536	16, p. 104	651	11.7.1, 11.7.5
Augsburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1537 (Moderate Reformed)	12, p. 58	338	11.7.1, 11.7.5, 11.12.3
Nördlingen, *Ordnung der ceremonien in der pfarkirchen zu Sant Georgen*, 1544	12, p. 319	373	11.10.2
Regensburg, *Ordnung für die Geistlichen zur Pestzeit*, 1562	13, p. 435	446	11.7.5
Kurpfalz, *Kirchenordnung*, 1563 (Reformed)	14, p. 406	504	11.4.6
Kurpfalz, *Kirchenratsordnung*, 1564 (Reformed)	14, p. 412	504	11.11.2
Brandenburg-Ansbach-Kulmbach, *Kapitelsordnung*, 1565	11, p. 350	283	11.11.3
Brandenburg-Ansbach-Kulmbach, *Begleitschreiben zur Konkordie von 1570*	11, p. 377	290	11.9.3
Regensburg, *Kirchenregimentsordnung*, 1572	13, p. 510	452	11.7.1, 11.7.5
Wolfstein, *Christliche Instructio des Thomas Stieber*, 1574	13, pp. 567, 569	463	11.8.2, 11.11.2
Pfalz-Veldenz, *Kirchenordnung*, 1574	18, p. 522	1011	11.5.3, 11.7.5, 11.10.4
Pfalz-Neuburg, *Generalartikel*, 1576	13, pp. 172, 197	404	11.7.5, 11.11.2
Strasbourg, *Gottesdienstordnung*, 1577	20/1, p. 518	1336	11.7.5
Hohenlohe, *Kirchenordnung*, 1578 (and Sehling's notes)	15, pp. 248, 263	574	11.5.1, 11.7.1, 11.7.5
Castell, *Dorfordnung für Obereisenheim*, 1579	11, p. 689	315	11.7.3, 11.7.5
Öhringen, *Befehl nach der Visitation*, 1581	15, p. 427	586	11.4.6
Kurpfalz, *Mandat gegen Kondemnationen*, 1584 (Reformed)	14, p. 512	507	11.9.3
Hohenlohe, *Fragen über die Kirchenzeremonien*, 1587 (and Sehling's notes on Assum)	15, p. 532	602	11.7.4, 11.8.3
Kurpfalz, *Ordnung der Classicalconvente*, 1587 (Reformed)	14, p. 530	510	11.6.3, 11.11.3
Sponheim (Hintere Grafschaft), *Kirchen- und Zensurordnung*, 1590	18, p. 652	1020	11.7.5, 11.13
Sayn, *Kirchenordnung*, 1590	19/1, p. 430	1090	11.4.6

Order	Sehling	Doc	§
Kurpfalz, mandates on the prayer days and the *Polizeiordnung*, 1591–1592 (Reformed)	19/2, pp. 777, 780, 785	1151, 1152, 1153	11.4.5, 11.12.2
Kurpfalz, *Generalvisitationsinstruktion*, 1594 (Reformed)	19/2, p. 822	1162	11.8.2
Hohenlohe, *Befehl wegen des Kirchengesangs und der Predigtlänge*, 1594	15, pp. 639–640	627	11.7.4, 11.7.5
Kurpfalz (Upper Palatinate), *Generalanweisung*, 1598 (Reformed)	13, p. 349	427	11.6.3, 11.9.3
Baden, *Kirchenordnungsmandat*, 1601	16, p. 552	713	11.7.5
Kurpfalz, *Kirchenordnung*, 1601 (with the variants of 1563) (Reformed)	14, pp. 557–558	515	11.5.2, 11.7.5, 11.10.3
Sponheim (Hintere Grafschaft), *Generalartikel*, 1608	18, p. 672	1021	11.8.3
Colmar, preachers' oaths, 1575–1615 (Sehling's introduction)	20/2, p. 479	1407	11.9.3

Hesse, Nassau and the Wetterau

Order	Sehling	Doc	§
Hesse, *Kirchenordnung*, 1566 (Moderate Reformed)	8, pp. 242, 260	2257	11.4.5, 11.6.2, 11.7.5
Nassau-Dillenburg, *Visitationsabschied*, 1570	10, p. 110	180	11.8.2
Nassau-Weilburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1576	10, pp. 229, 232, 235	198	11.7.2, 11.7.5
Ysenburg-Birstein, *Kirchenzuchtordnung*, 1588	10, p. 638	229	11.12.1
Ysenburg-Ronneburg, *Kirchenzuchtordnung*, 1591 (Reformed)	10, p. 595	222	11.7.5, 11.12.3
Ysenburg-Birstein, *Kirchenordnung*, 1598 (Reformed)	10, p. 655	231	11.7.5
Hanau-Münzenberg, order of 1600 (Reformed)	10, p. 536	211	11.11.3

Brandenburg, Silesia, Prussia, Mecklenburg and Kurland

Order	Sehling	Doc	§
Gardelegen (Sehling's introduction)	3, p. 218	1766	11.4.6, 11.11.1
Bagow, *Visitations-Abschied und Matrikel*, 1553; Brandenburg town order of 1551	3, pp. 153, 204	1754, 1763	11.8.1
Salzwedel (Neustadt), order of 1579	3, p. 290	1780	11.11.1
Troppau, *Kirchenordnungen für Freudenthal und Goldstein*, 1584–1592	3, p. 478	1824	11.7.3, 11.7.5
Mecklenburg, *Conformitas ceremoniarum*, c. 1560	5, p. 290	1936	11.4.6, 11.5.3, 11.7.5
Prussia, *Kirchenordnung und ceremonien*, 1568	4, pp. 74, 93	1833	11.7.5, 11.10.4
Mecklenburg, *Consistorialordnung*, 1570	5, p. 245	1926	11.9.1
Kurland, *Kurländische Kirchenordnung*, 1570	5, p. 92	1907	11.10.2

Lower Saxony, Westphalia and the North

Order	Sehling	Doc	§
East Frisia, Norden, 1528 (Reformed) (editor's note on the medieval pulpit office)	7/1, p. 431	2111	11.10.1
Schleswig-Holstein, *Kirchenordnung*, 1542	23, p. 91	1576	11.6.3, 11.7.5, 11.9.1
Lower Saxon Circle, *Abschied des Lüneburger Kreistages*, 1562	23, p. 177	1582	11.9.3
Bremen, *Mandat zum Verbot des Scheltens auf der Kanzel*, 1562 (Philippist)	7/2.2, p. 540	2223	11.9.3
Oldenburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1573	7/2.1, p. 1109	2151	11.4.6
Grubenhagen, *Kirchenordnung*, 1581	6/2, p. 1065	2058	11.4.7
Osnabrück, *Agende* (1588), 1618	7/1, p. 287	2101	11.11.2
Calenberg-Göttingen, *Visitationsinstruktion*, 1588	6/2, p. 883	2040	11.11.2
Soest, *Artikel der Prediger*, 1590	22, p. 480	1536	11.4.6
Corvey, *Kirchenordnung für das Corveyer Stiftsdorf Bruchhausen*, 1603	21, pp. 244–245	1455	11.6.1, 11.7.5, 11.10.4, 11.12.3
Gottorf, *Predigtmandat*, 1609 (Sehling's introduction)	23, pp. 323–324	1613	11.9.3
Schaumburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1614	7/2.2, p. 117	2178	11.10.4

Chapter 12. The Liturgical Calendar

This chapter covers the church year in the evangelical church orders of the sixteenth century, as printed in Emil Sehling's *Die evangelischen Kirchenordnungen des XVI. Jahrhunderts* (The Evangelical Church Orders of the Sixteenth Century). It asks:

- **Which days did the orders keep, and why?** What principles decided which feasts stayed, and which went?
- **How were the feasts ranked?** What happened to the medieval grades (*summum*, *duplex*, *semiduplex*, *simplex*), to octaves, vigils and the transfer of feasts?
- **How was a feast kept in church?** What special rubrics, chants, ceremonies and services did the high feasts have, and what was abolished?
- **How was a feast kept in common life?** What rest from work did the orders require, how was it enforced, and what became of markets, weddings, guild feasts and the folk festivals of the year?
- **How were the seasons kept?** Were there more services in Advent, Lent and Holy Week? What became of Rogation week and the Ember days? Which seasons were closed to weddings?
- **What fasts were kept, by whom, where and why?**

How the chapter is laid out.

- §12.1 summarizes the findings, and §12.2 sets out the sources and method.
- §§12.3–12.9 deal with the feasts themselves:
  - §12.3, why feasts were kept at all;
  - §12.4, the medieval grades;
  - §12.5, the Lutheran scale of feasts;
  - §12.6, whole and half holy days;
  - §12.7, the following days of the high feasts;
  - §12.8, individual feasts;
  - §12.9, the *Vierzeiten* (the four times).
- §12.10 covers the ceremonial marks of the feasts in church, the festal ceremonies that were abolished, and the seasonal changes in the service.
- §12.11 covers the keeping of holy days in common life.
- §12.12 covers the seasons: Advent, Lent, Holy Week, Rogation week, the closed seasons and the Ember days.
- §12.13 covers fasting.
- §12.14 deals with occurrence and transfer, and §12.15 with the short calendars of the Upper German towns and the Reformed.
- §12.16 is a concordance of every order quoted.

Each topic is supported by quotations in the original language (Early New High German, Low German or Latin), each followed by an English translation.

12.1 Summary of findings

12.1.1 The main findings

1. The medieval grades did not survive as grades of feasts.

- No order ranks a feast as *duplex*, *semiduplex* or *simplex*, and none has a system of Office grades (§12.4.1).
- The old vocabulary survives in fragments:
  - *summum* (the highest [chant]) and *minus summum* (the lesser summum) as names of Kyrie melodies (Pomerania 1542, Buxtehude 1565, Nördlingen 1544, Hof 1592);
  - *summa festa* (highest feasts) as a name for the highest feasts (Hadersleben 1528, Tangermünde 1603, Gottorf 1587);
  - the ferial, dominical and festal forms of the Office in chapters and convents;
  - the adverbs *ferialiter* (in the ferial manner), *festive* (festally) and *solenniter* (solemnly);
  - *per anticipationem* (by anticipation) for moving a feast forward (§§12.4.2–12.4.6, 12.14.2).
- Octaves have gone; the "following days" of the high feasts take their place (§12.7). So have vigil fasts; first vespers on the eve take their place (§12.4.6).

2. The ranking is theological. The orders rank feasts by what they commemorate:

- the feasts of Christ, and above all his birth, resurrection and the sending of the Spirit;
- then the days whose "history is written in the Gospel": the Purification, the Annunciation, John the Baptist, the Visitation;
- then the apostles, kept for their example;
- then nothing, for feasts that rest on legend (Corpus Christi, the Holy Cross, the Conception, Nativity and Assumption of Mary).

The formula "not for the days' sake, but for the history's sake" (Bugenhagen, §12.3.3) states the test. Luther's *Formula missae* (Form of the Mass) of 1523 gives its first form (§12.3.1).

3. The rank is kept by civil and ceremonial means. Most orders do not tell the ranks apart by the liturgical form of the service. They do so by:

- whether work is forbidden all day, until noon, only during the sermon, or not at all (§12.6);
- how many sermons are preached (§12.6.3);
- how many days the feast lasts (§12.7);
- a set of ceremonial marks (§12.10): Latin chant, the grade of the Kyrie, proper prefaces, sequences, figural music and organ, vestments and elevation, bells, the Athanasian Creed, communion, and bans on weddings, markets and guild feasts (§12.11.3).

4. The usual scale has three ranks below Sunday (§12.5.1):

- the high or chief feasts of Christ;
- a second rank of other Gospel feasts (John the Baptist, the Visitation, Michaelmas, and often Purification and Annunciation);
- the apostles' days as half holy days.

Some orders draw two ranks only (Luther, Homberg 1526 (Moderate Reformed), and in effect the Reformed orders of §12.15). Others number three classes (Grubenhagen 1544, Regensburg 1567, Hoya 1571, Harlingerland 1573/74). Sayn 1582 has four, the fourth being the abolished feasts (§12.5.5). Danzig and Thorn speak of "great" and "small" feasts (§12.5.6).

5. The families of orders follow their models.

- **Saxon and Mecklenburg family** (§12.5.2). Saxony 1539 and Mecklenburg 1552 set the pattern: "hohe heubtfest des herrn Christi" (high chief feasts of the Lord Christ) first, then "besides these chiefest feasts" the apostles, John, Visitation and Michaelmas, kept in the forenoon. It was taken up across the north and in Pfalz-Zweibrücken.
- **Württemberg family** (§12.5.3). Holy days are proclaimed by the magistrate. At first there is one list, later divided into whole days and forenoon days.
- **Bugenhagen family** (§12.5.4). "The three great feasts of Christ" are kept three full days each. The other Gospel feasts are also kept fully. The apostles are moved to the next Sunday.

6. Whole and half holy days (§12.6). From the 1560s the orders of the Harz, Hesse, the Rhine and the Main set out day-by-day tables of whole and half days: Mansfeld 1580, Pfalz-Zweibrücken 1561, Landau 1562, Pfalz-Veldenz 1574, Ysenburg 1582, Nassau-Weilburg 1609 and 1618, Solms 1603. Harvest, markets and craftsmen's work pushed the summer feasts down to half days or onto Sundays. The Transylvanian synod of 1578 has the technical term: the apostles' days are kept *intercise*, "by halves" (§12.6.4).

7. The middle rank is where the orders differ most (§12.8).

- **Michaelmas.** It rose to be one of the four chief feasts in the north, in place of the Assumption (§12.8.5, §12.9).
- **The Assumption.** It was abolished in most orders. In Franconia and Tecklenburg it was kept "for the working country-folk" but preached as the Visitation (§12.8.3).
- **The Visitation.** It was moved to 15 August in the Nürnberg family (§12.6.4).
- **Purification and Annunciation.** Everywhere they are treated as feasts of Christ, but their rank ranges from whole holy day to half day (§12.8.1).

8. The *Vierzeiten* (§12.9). In north Germany the top rank had a fiscal name: the four feasts (Christmas, Easter, Whitsuntide and Michaelmas, formerly the Assumption) on which the "four-times penny" was paid. The payment made the rank, and the rank

carried liturgical marks:

- a sermon at first vespers (Wolfenbüttel 1543);
- a Latin Mass (Hoya 1571);
- proper prefaces (Lippe 1571).

9. Occurrence and transfer (§12.14). The orders keep simple rules of precedence:

- A feast of Christ on a Sunday displaces the Sunday Gospel; an apostle's day yields to it.
- An apostle's day on a Saturday goes to the Sunday.
- The Annunciation in Holy Week is moved in at least six different ways.

Some orders forbid pastors to move feasts on their own authority.

10. The minimum (§12.15). The Upper German cities (Mülhausen 1529, Reformed; Augsburg 1537, Esslingen 1537 and Strasbourg 1544, Moderate Reformed) and the Reformed territories (Kurpfalz 1563, Nassau-Dillenburg 1582, Anhalt 1599) kept only Sunday and a few feasts of Christ, which reduced the ranking to Luther's two ranks. Esslingen's return to the apostles' days after the "blue Mondays" of 1537 shows how unstable that minimum was.

11. Feasts in church (§12.10). Besides the marks of rank, the orders abolished the acted ceremonies of the medieval year: the Palm Sunday ass, the Good Friday grave, the Easter image, the Ascension figure, the Whitsun dove, the Christmas cradle, and all processions with holy water, crosses and the sacrament (§12.10.10). Some orders kept seasonal changes in the chant: the plain Kyrie and no *Gloria* in Advent and Lent, the Creed for "Nun bitten" (Now pray we the Holy Ghost) in Advent (§12.10.11).

12. Feasts in common life (§12.11).

- **Rest in three degrees.** Sunday and the high feasts were kept wholly. The lesser holy days were kept until noon, or only during the sermon (§12.11.1).
- **Enforcement** was by the magistrate: town gates shut on holy-day mornings, fines, taverns closed, horses unharnessed (§12.11.2).
- **Weddings, guild feasts and markets** were moved away from the high feasts (§12.11.3).
- **The folk festivals** were attacked as "heathen" in mandate after mandate: *Fastnacht* (Shrovetide), *Kirchweih* (church dedication festival), Walpurgis and May, the Whitsun ales, the Midsummer fires and the *Hagelfeier* (hail holiday) (§12.11.4).
- **Shrove Sunday** was turned by Bugenhagen into a feast of baptism (§12.11.5).

13. The seasons (§12.12).

- **Luther** would not show off Lent, Holy Week or Good Friday "with other rites" than the rest of the year (§12.12.1).
- **Lent** kept its name and became a season of preaching:
  - repentance and the Passion;
  - more weekday sermons;
  - a daily catechism at the hour of the old *Salve Regina*;
  - Sunday examinations before the Easter communion.

  There was no daily Lenten Mass (§12.12.3).
- **Advent** was kept for preaching on the prophecies and the Last Day (§12.12.2). **Holy Week** was kept for the Supper on Maundy Thursday and the Passion on Good Friday (§12.12.4).
- **The catechism seasons.** Rogation week, Advent, Lent and harvest became Bugenhagen's four catechism seasons (§12.12.5).
- **Closed seasons.** Weddings were still forbidden in Advent and Lent and at the high feasts, for a new reason: they drew people from the sermon (§12.12.6).
- **The Ember days** lost their fast but kept their dates. They became the quarter days for payments, catechism series, the Litany, ordinations and the reading of ordinances (§12.12.7).

14. Fasting (§12.13).

- **The obligation abolished.** The fixed fasts (Lent, Fridays, Ember days, vigils) were abolished as obligations binding the conscience. Fasting was still praised as good "to tame the body" and was to last "the time of our life" (§12.13.1).
- **Exhorted, but free.** The earliest orders exhort the people to keep the old fast days freely (§12.13.2).
- **The old fasts kept.** A few, such as Waldeck 1528 and the Catholic Margrave of Baden, kept the old fasts (§12.13.3).
- **Civil abstinence.** Magistrates ordered meat-free days for economic reasons and said so: the Nordhausen police order of 1549, which exempts the old, the sick, labourers, children and women in childbed (§12.13.4).
- **The new fasts** were appointed days of fasting and prayer in time of war, plague and danger, and fasting before the choice of ministers (§12.13.5).
- **Before communion.** The one regular fast was the communicant's: the sacrament received fasting, and no banquets on the eve of Sundays and feasts (§12.13.6).

12.1.2 What became of the medieval categories

Medieval category	In the evangelical orders	§
duplex, *semiduplex*, *simplex*, *totum duplex*	not found as grades of feasts	12.4.1
summum (the highest [chant]), *minus summum* (the lesser summum), *paschale* (Easter [Kyrie]), *dominicale* (Sunday [Kyrie]), *angelicum* (angelic [Kyrie]), *apostolicum* (apostles' [Kyrie]), *feriale* (Kyrie and Gloria melodies)	kept as chant grades in some orders; *summa festa* (highest feasts) as the name of the top rank	12.4.2, 12.10.2
festum fori (feast of the court) / *festum chori* (feast of the choir)	replaced by whole and half holy days, and by days kept "without a commanded holy day"	12.5.2, 12.6
nine lessons and three lessons	three-lesson matins the norm; nine lessons in some chapters; three lessons for high feasts in villages	12.4.3
proper and common of saints	proper Office for high feasts; *commune sanctorum* (common of the saints) for saints' days in convents	12.4.4
octaves	not kept; forbidden for saints (Ansbach 1533); St Stephen's octave abolished (Mülhausen 1524, Reformed); replaced by the two or three "following days"	12.4.4, 12.7, 12.15
vigils	vigil fasts abolished; first vespers on the eve, with confession, and on higher feasts a sermon	12.4.6
occurrence and transfer	simplified rules of precedence and transfer, including *per anticipationem* (by anticipation)	12.14
patronal and local feasts	abolished, turned into thanksgivings, or kept with a sermon (Wied 1564, Reformed)	12.4.5, 12.8.9

12.1.3 Terms of rank used in the orders

Term	Meaning in the orders	Examples (§)
hohe Feste (high feasts), *hohe heubtfest des herrn Christi*, *Hauptfeste* (chief feasts)	the highest rank: the feasts of Christ, or the three or four great feasts	Saxony 1539, Mecklenburg 1552 (12.5.2); Henneberg 1582 (12.6.3)
de dre groten feste Christi (the three great feasts of Christ)	Christmas, Easter, Whitsuntide	Braunschweig 1528, Schleswig-Holstein 1542 (12.5.4)

Term	Meaning in the orders	Examples (§)
vier Zeiten (four times), *veer tide* (the four times), *vier hochzeitliche feste*, *Vierzeitenfest* (four-times feast)	the four chief feasts on which the four-times penny was paid	Lübeck 1531, Waldeck 1525, Hoya 1571 (12.9)
summa festa (highest feasts), *summae festivitates*, *in summis festis* (on the highest feasts)	the highest feasts	Hadersleben 1528, Tangermünde 1603, Gottorf 1587 (12.4.2)
fürnembste (chiefest), *furnemliche*, *vornemlichste Feste* (chiefest feasts)	the chiefest feasts (often the whole list of holy days)	Mecklenburg 1552 (12.5.2), Württemberg 1553 (12.3.5), Northeim 1539 (12.3.5)
andere herliche fest (other glorious feasts)	the second rank	Grubenhagen 1544 (12.5.5)
mittelmeßige festa (middling feasts)	middle feasts, kept as half days	Sayn 1582 (12.5.5)
gemeine Feste, *gemeine Feiertage* (common holy days)	common feasts: the lower ranks	Pfalz-Zweibrücken 1561 (12.6.2), Henneberg 1582 (12.6.3)
große (great) and *kleine Feste*, *kleine oder halbe feste* (small or half feasts)	great and small feasts	Danzig 1612, Thorn 1575 (12.5.6)
ganz (whole), *halb gefeiert* (half kept); *bis Mittag* (until midday); *vormittag* (forenoon); *bis die Sermon geendet* (until the sermon is ended)	whole and half holy days	6
ohne gebotene Feier (without commanded rest)	declared, but without commanded rest	Merseburg 1544 (12.5.2)
ungefeiret in gedechtnus (remembered without being kept holy)	remembered, but not kept holy	Pfalz-Neuburg 1543 (12.5.7)
solenniter (solemnly), *festive* (festally), *festivaliter*	in solemn, festal manner	Schwarzburg 1587 (12.7.1), Leisnig 1529 (12.4.5), Pomerania 1569 (12.10.2)
ferialiter (in the ferial manner)	(a) in the weekday form, without *Gloria*; (b) as a holiday	Anhalt 1551, 1568; Wied 1564 (Reformed) (12.4.5)
intercise, *dimidiatim*	by halves	Mediasch 1578 (12.6.4)
per anticipationem (by anticipation)	moved back before its date	Wintzingerode (12.14.1)
de tempore (of the season), *de festo*, *commune sanctorum* (common of the saints)	the proper of the season or feast; the common of saints	Mecklenburg 1552 (12.5.2), Crevese 1541 (12.4.4)

12.2 Scope, sources and method

12.2.1 The corpus

The corpus is Sehling's edition, volumes 1–24, as held in `eko.db`. It has 2,350 document records in 30 digitized volumes and half-volumes, with Sehling's own subject registers linked to the pages. The edition prints church orders, agendas, visitation instructions and recesses, parish reports and council decrees. It also prints editorial introductions and notes. This chapter quotes only the sixteenth- and early seventeenth-century texts. The editors' notes are cited as such where they matter.

12.2.2 How the corpus was searched

Every document was scanned with regular expressions for the groups of terms below. Matches were read in context, and then the full passages were pulled from the relevant orders.

- **Medieval grades and rubrical terms.**

    - *summum* (the highest [chant]), *duplex*, *semiduplex*, *simplex*, *totum duplex*, *triplex* (triple), the abbreviations *dupl.* (double) and *semidupl.* (semidouble);
    - *festum fori* (feast of the court), *festum chori* (feast of the choir);
    - *novem* (nine) / *tres lectiones* (three lessons);
    - *classis* (class), *festivitas* (festivity), *solemnitas* (solemnity);
    - *festive* (festally), *solenniter* (solemnly), *ferialiter* (in the ferial manner);
    - *commune sanctorum* (common of the saints), *octava* (octave), *vigilia* (vigil);
    - *per anticipationem* (by anticipation), *transferre* (transfer).
- **German and Low German terms of rank.**
    - *hohe* (high), *höchste* (highest), *große* (great) and *kleine Feste* (small feasts), *Hauptfest* (chief feast), *fürnembste Feste* (chiefest feasts);
    - *halbe* (half) and *ganze Feiertage* (whole holy days), "bis Mittag" (until midday), "vormittag" (forenoon);
    - *Aposteltage* (apostles' days), *Marienfeste* (feasts of Mary), the "third day";
    - *gebannte Feiertage* (commanded holy days), *verlegen* (move), *verschieben* (put off), and their Low German forms (*vyrdage*, *hochtide*, *veer tide*).
- **Ceremonial markers.**
    - the *Vierzeiten* (the four times) and the four-times penny;
    - the Kyrie grades (*summum*, *paschale*, *dominicale*, *angelicum*, *apostolicum*, *festivale*, *feriale*, *Fons bonitatis*, *Magnae Deus*) and the *Benedicamus* grades;
    - proper prefaces;
    - bells and chiming (*beiern*).
- **The names of the feasts themselves.** These were searched in lists and in rules for transfer.
- **The seasons and fasting** (added for the fuller calendar):
    - *Advent*, *Fasten* (Lent), *vasten* (Lent), *Quadragesima* (Lent), *Marterwoche* (Passion week), *Gründonnerstag* (Maundy Thursday), *Karfreitag* (Good Friday), *Kreuzwoche* (Rogation week), *Bittwoche* (Rogation week), *Hagelfeier* (hail holiday);
    - *Quatember* (Ember days), *Fronfasten* (Ember days), *quatertemper* (Ember days);
    - *fleisch essen* (eat flesh), *Fasttag* (fast day), *Bußtag* (day of repentance), *nüchtern* (fasting);
    - *Fastnacht* (Shrovetide), *vastelavend* (Shrovetide), *Aschermittwoch* (Ash Wednesday);
    - *Hochzeit* (wedding) with *Advent* and *Fasten*.
- **Holy days in common life.** *Sonntag* (Sunday) and *Feiertag* (holy day) with *arbeit* (work), *fahren* (travel), *kaufen* (buy), *kram* (trade), *zechen* (carouse), *tanzen* (dance); *Kirchweih* (church dedication festival), *Kirmes* (parish fair); *Walpurgis*, *Johannisfeuer*, *Meyen*; the festal ceremonies (*Palmesel*, *Kindelwiegen*, *Auffahrt*, *Tauben*).

Sehling's subject registers were also used: *Feiertage* (holy days; 380 page references), *Festtage* (feast days) and *Festtage/-Zeiten* (feast days and seasons) (377), *Aposteltage* (135), *Feiertagsordnung* (holy-day order) (77), *Vigilien* (vigils) (95), *Marienfeste* (27).

Related chapters.

- Chapter 8 covers the hymns of the seasons and feasts, the *Gloria* in Advent and Lent, and the *Leisen* of the high feasts.
- Chapter 4 covers the proper prefaces, sequences and the propers of the feasts.
- Chapter 5 covers the collects of the seasons and the Lenten *super populum* (over the people) prayers.
- Chapter 10 covers Vespers and the eves of feasts.
- Chapter 11 covers Passion, prayer-day and catechism sermons and the duties of hearers.
- Chapter 13 covers the Litany days and the rites of the feasts and seasons (§§13.21.4, 13.23).
- Chapter 9 covers the organ and the bells (§§9.3.6, 9.5).
- Chapter 14 covers vestments and colours (§§14.6.6, 14.7).
- Chapter 2 covers the Kyrie and the Gloria by season (§§2.6.2, 2.7.1).
- Chapter 15 covers the catechism seasons as times of instruction (§15.11.1).

12.2.3 Cautions

- **Record headings and dates in the database.** A database record often holds more than one order, and its year field can be wrong. In this chapter every order is named from the running head of the page on which the quotation stands. Some examples:

    - The Henneberg record is dated 1555 in the database but holds texts from 1545 to 1582. The feast rules are in the *Kirchenordnung* (church order) of Georg Ernst of 1582.
    - The Danzig record contains the St Mary's order of 1567, the church fathers' compilation of 1612, and several Elbing and Thorn texts, among them the Thorn order of 1575.
    - A record among the East Frisian orders, dated 1593 in the database, holds on the pages quoted the Harlingerland order of 1573/74.
    - The Sayn record labelled "1314" holds the *Kirchenzuchtordnung* of 1582 and the *Kirchenordnung* of 1590.
    - The Mansfeld feast lists belong to the *Kirchen-agenda* (church agenda) of 1580.
    - The Anhalt record holds orders from 1532 to 1572.
- **Editorial summaries and apparatus.** A few texts are quoted from the editors' apparatus, not the main text, and are marked as such:
    - Saxony 1539 is printed partly as a summary with quotations.
    - Variants: Nassau-Weilburg's *Agende* of 1618, Brenz's recension B, the German text B of the Burzenland articles, and the Latin report of the Mediasch synod.
- **Two-column prints.** Where the edition prints in two columns, the digitized text sometimes interleaves them. The Danzig list of 1612 and the Schwarzburg list of 1587 are examples. Quotations skip the interleaved matter and mark the gap with "[…]".
- **Silence.** When an order does not mention a feast, it is not always abolished. Many orders list only the days that are holy days. Days kept "ungefeiret in gedechtnus", in memory but without rest, often go unnamed.

12.3 Why keep feasts at all: the principles behind the ranking

Before an order ranks feasts, it usually says why any feast besides Sunday should be kept. Its answer decides the ranking:

- **The feasts of Christ.** Those that set forth the work of redemption come first.
- **Feasts with a Gospel history.** Feasts whose history is told in the Gospel come next.
- **The apostles and the rest.** The apostles, and other days kept only for their examples, come last.
- **Legend and abuse.** Feasts with no ground in Scripture, or bound up with abuse, are abolished.

The passages below give the main forms of the argument.

12.3.1 Luther, *Formula missae*, 1523

Wittenberg, Luther, *Formula missae et communionis*, 1523 (Sehling 1, p. 5):

First, the introits of the Sundays and of the feasts of Christ, namely of Easter, Pentecost and the Nativity, we approve and keep, although we had rather have the psalms from which they are taken, as of old; but now we will bear with the received use. And if any will approve the introits of the apostles, of the Virgin, and of other saints (when they are taken out of the psalms or other Scriptures), we condemn them not. We at Wittenberg seek to keep sabbath only on the Lord's days and the feasts of the Lord; the feasts of all the saints we judge are to be utterly abrogated, or, if there be aught worthy in them, to be mingled into the Sunday sermons. The feast of the Purification and of the Annunciation we hold for feasts of Christ, as also the Epiphany and the Circumcision. In the stead of the feast of St Stephen and of John the Evangelist, the office of the Nativity pleaseth us. The feasts of the Holy Cross, let them be anathema. Let others do according to their own conscience, or for the infirmity of others, what the Spirit shall suggest.

Note. This is the charter of the Lutheran calendar. It sets out four points:

- **Two ranks only.** Sundays and "feasts of the Lord" are kept, and nothing else.
- **Marian feasts reclassified.** The two Marian feasts with a Gospel history, the Purification and the Annunciation, are counted as feasts of Christ.
- **Stephen and John absorbed.** Their days are taken into Christmas.
- **Holy Cross.** The feasts of the Holy Cross are damned outright.

The last sentence leaves room for local custom, and most later orders used it. They kept the apostles, the Visitation, John the Baptist and Michaelmas at a lower rank.

12.3.2 Homberg, 1526: only the mysteries of redemption

The Homberg synod's *Reformatio* is a Moderate Reformed order of Philip of Hesse's church.

Hessen, *Reformatio ecclesiarum Hassiae* (Homberg), 1526, cap. 8 (Moderate Reformed; Sehling 8, p. 49):

Of feasts and commemorations, chapter 8. [38] Beside the Lord's day let no feast be celebrated, save for the mysteries of our redemption. Wherefore let these only be kept henceforth: of the Nativity of Christ, of the Circumcision, of the Epiphany, of the Presentation of the Lord in the temple, of the Incarnation of the Word of God or Annunciation, of the day of the Preparation, of Easter the first day, of the Ascension, and of Pentecost the first day; item the day of the Visitation of the Blessed Mary. […] For the celebration of these standeth not in superstitious deeds, but in the frequent use of the holy Word and in works of mercy.

Note. This is the strictest one-rank calendar of any Lutheran-leaning order in the corpus:

- **Nothing between Sunday and the feasts of redemption.** There are no apostles, no John the Baptist and no Michaelmas.
- **One day each.** Easter and Pentecost are kept for their "first day" only.

The Homberg *Reformatio* was never put into force. The later Hessian orders (also Moderate Reformed) keep more (§§12.3.5, 12.3.6).

12.3.3 "Not for the days' sake, but for the histories": Bugenhagen

Braunschweig, *Kirchenordnung* (Bugenhagen), 1528 (Sehling 6/1, p. 380):

We are before God in our consciences bound to no time; but such is done for the service of the common people, forasmuch as all the parts of holy Scripture cannot be handled at one time. Therefore we keep also the high feasts of Christ, and others whereof histories are written in the Gospel, not for the days' sake, which (before God and with Christians of right understanding) are worth alike, the one as much as the other, but for the histories' sake, to preach them.

Note. The same words stand in Hamburg 1529 (Sehling 5, pp. 513–514) and, in shorter form, in the other Bugenhagen orders. The test, "whereof histories are written in the Gospel", is the one most later orders use to rank a feast.

Schleswig-Holstein, *Kirchenordnung*, 1542 (Sehling 23, p. 95):

Of holy days. For we must retain certain feasts, not for the days' sake, but because of the preaching of the divine Word, that all the parts of the holy Gospel may be conveniently expounded. We accept no holy days save only the wonted Sundays, whereon men may rest from labour, hear the Word of God, receive the Sacrament, and pray in common for every need, and also thank God for his benefits.

12.3.4 A school timetable of doctrine

Saxony (Ernestine), *Unterricht der Visitatoren*, 1528 (Sehling 1, p. 164):

Which feasts are so ordained because one cannot teach all the parts of the Gospel at once. Therefore such doctrine hath been divided through the year, as in a school one ordaineth to read Virgil on one day and Homer on another.

The Württemberg order has the feasts of Christ follow the order of his acts. **Württemberg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1536** (Sehling 16, p. 105):

We have thought it good that one feast be kept after another, and that in the feasts of Christ that very order be held which, in the deeds themselves, according to the natural order and to the supernatural divine appointment and working, hath shewn itself so graciously one after another, from the beginning of the conception and incarnation of Christ our dearest Saviour, unto our redemption and eternal glory.

12.3.5 Not a commandment of God: a civil and pastoral ordinance

Schwäbisch Hall, Brenz, *Kirchenordnung*, 1527 (Sehling 17/1, p. 53):

Among Christians there is no outward holy day commanded of God, as the Sabbath and other feasts have been among the Jews; but there is a continual, everlasting Sabbath or holy day, beginning from baptism and lasting unto death, wherein no unrighteous business shall ever be performed. Yet in a Christian congregation, for outward necessity, an order in days and times, with holy days and working days, may be kept in seemly order and outward unity; not for the conscience, as commanded of God and needful to godliness and salvation

Schwäbisch Hall, Brenz, sermon on the magistrate's ordinance of holy days, 1527 (Sehling 17/1, p. 78):

Now the royal way is to hold feast days not necessary to eternal felicity, but to honest civil peace and concord and to rest from labour. For that which lacketh alternate rest is not durable. And in this way goeth the commandment of the civil magistrate concerning feasts. For he hath ordained feast days not as necessary to divine righteousness, but for the public peace and quiet, that this may be a civil ordinance, not a superstition of the papacy.

Northeim, *Kirchenordnung*, 1539 (Sehling 6/2, p. 934):

Although it is needless to set up many feast days, and no man also ought to be bound to such holy days, by virtue of Christian liberty, as the epistle to the Colossians in the second chapter witnesseth; yet for the weak's sake, forasmuch as the Gospel is among us yet in some measure new, certain principal feasts have had to be ordained, that the Word may be the more worthily set forth and heard.

The Hessian order of 1532 (Moderate Reformed) also justifies the apostles' days by the need for rest. **Hessen, *Kirchenordnung*, 1532** (Moderate Reformed; Sehling 8, p. 75):

We say not that these days are better or holier than others, but that the great need of the common man and of the unlearned youth, taken in this wise, requireth it; who otherwise, hindered by their labour, have no time to learn at the least the most needful parts of the Christian faith. Moreover it is also otherwise brotherly and civil that both men and cattle be let have their rest at times.

The Württemberg preamble of 1553 was copied into the Kurpfalz order of 1556, Pfalz-Zweibrücken 1557, Nördlingen 1579 and others. **Württemberg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1553** (Sehling 16, p. 266):

Forasmuch then as the order of holy days serveth the common Church to this end, that it may know an appointed time to resort to the sermon and to the ministering of the holy Sacraments; and the common temporal laws, to shew their obedient service toward Christ the Son of God and his Church, give their special freedom to the chiefest holy days: we will that the days hereafter named be proclaimed for holy days, and kept according to Christian duty

12.3.6 "The feast of all feasts": Hessen, 1566

Hessen, *Kirchenordnung*, 1566 (Moderate Reformed; Sehling 8, pp. 257–258):

we also have purposed to keep certain feasts of Christ. […] Chrysostom […] in a sermon on the holy Philogonius rehearseth certain feasts of Christ, and calleth the incarnation and birth of Christ the feast of all feasts. For out of this have Epiphany, Easter, the Ascension and Pentecost their ground and origin.

Note. This is the only place in the corpus where one feast is ranked above all the others, and it is done by patristic argument. The order does not draw a liturgical consequence. Its feasts of Christ are kept "in the form of the Sunday", with only the chants, lessons and prayers changed (p. 258).

12.3.7 The test of Scripture history

Saxony (Albertine), *Kirchenordnung* of Duke Heinrich, 1539 (Sehling 1, p. 274):

Over and above the common Sundays shall be kept the high chief feasts of the Lord Christ, which from of old in Christendom were ordained to this end: that the several parts of the history or story of Christ which are confessed in the Creed might be kept in the remembrance of the common people, and those same articles of the Christian faith handled thereon. To such feasts of Christ belong also some of those that were hitherto kept for the Virgin Mary.

Note. This paragraph, the list that follows it (§12.5.2) and the rule for the apostles' days became the model for the Mecklenburg order of 1552. Through that order it reached the Brunswick, Lüneburg, Oldenburg, Lippe, Verden and Palatinate-Zweibrücken

orders.

Pfalz-Neuburg uses the same test to decide which days break the continuous reading of Scripture. **Pfalz-Neuburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1543** (Sehling 13, p. 71):

Yet excepted the high feasts which have their histories, for the sake whereof they were set up, in holy Scripture, as Christmas, Twelfth Day, Candlemas, the Annunciation, Palm Sunday, Easter, Ascension Day, Whitsunday, John the Baptist, the Visitation, etc.; for on these feasts one shall read, for the epistle and Gospel, the chapters out of the Bible wherein the history of the feast is written and which are otherwise appointed thereto.

Gera, *Kirchen-Ordnung*, 1556 (Sehling 2, p. 158; an extract of the order of the Vogtland superintendents made at Plauen in 1552):

III. Feasts and holy days. Beside the wonted Sunday, the feasts of Christ and of the holy apostles which give Gospels and histories in the Scripture shall be solemnly kept in all congregations; and on them God's Word shall be diligently preached, and the divine office also held with the ministering of the sacraments, where there be communicants, and in especial the catechism be always taught in the afternoon. But hereby shall be meant these following, and no other feasts of the saints or otherwise papistical.

Transylvania, Honterus, *Reformationsbüchlein*, 1543 (Sehling 24, p. 189; Latin):

The feast days, because of manifold abuses, we have drawn into a narrow compass, yet keeping all those which have been received in the general Church for the histories contained in the holy writings.

Kosd and Schelken chapters (Transylvania), statutes, 1577 (Sehling 24, p. 400):

We will in no wise that there be in our churches any variety in the feasts to be celebrated, but let the catalogue of feast days delivered in the Reformation of the church of Kronstadt be observed. But those that are not written therein (as having, namely, no history in holy writ) let them be omitted.

The Riga order gives a reason of this kind for keeping the Visitation. **Riga, *Kirchenordnung*, 1530** (Sehling 5, p. 17):

All the feasts of Christ our Lord and Redeemer will we keep, that the remembrance of the wholesome and great gracious works which were done for our comfort may be kept yearly with sermons and exhortation of the people; namely Christmas, the Circumcision, the Epiphany, the Purification, the Annunciation, Easter, Pentecost, with the other days following, also the Ascension of Christ, and the Visitation, forasmuch as that was the first revelation of Christ, when he was yet in his mother's womb

At Regensburg the feasts that the town's Catholics still keep are dropped, because they lack a Scripture history. **Regensburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1567** (Sehling 13, p. 474):

And although in our city the papists keep many more holy days, as of George, of Corpus Christi, of Mary Magdalene, of Laurence, of the Assumption of Mary, of the Nativity of Mary, of All Saints, of Martin, of Catherine, of Nicholas, yet we have at last let go the keeping of them, with foregoing sufficient admonition to the Christian congregation, how such feasts not only have no history of holy Scripture at all, but are used by the adverse part, as wholly papistical, with the highest idolatry and to the confirming of the same, against the pure doctrine of our churches.

12.3.8 The Sabbath argument: Sunday first in dignity

Most Lutheran orders treat the choice of days as free. The synodal order of the Bohemian Brethren (Hussite), printed among the Posen texts, grounds Sunday's precedence in the moral law. **Posen, Bohemian Brethren, synodal order, 1576** (Bohemian Brethren; Sehling 4, p. 285):

VII. The custom concerning feast days. Among the feast days we give the first dignity to the seventh day, the Lord's, which we judge it lawful for no man to employ in outward and servile works, under any pretext even of Christian liberty; and that because we acknowledge its institution not for a ceremony, but for a part of the moral law, everlastingly inviolable.

12.4 The medieval grades and what became of them

The late-medieval rite ranked a feast in two ways. The first was its liturgical grade: *totum duplex*, *duplex*, *semiduplex* and *simplex*, with *summum* (the highest [chant]) or *duplex maius* at the top in many diocesan uses. The second was its civil status: a *festum*

fori (feast of the court), on which work was forbidden, or a *festum chori*, kept only in choir. The grade decided the Office: nine lessons or three, proper or common, first vespers, an octave, the colour and the ceremony. This section asks which of these terms and categories the evangelical orders kept.

12.4.1 *Duplex*, *semiduplex*, *simplex*: absent

No order in the corpus uses *duplex*, *semiduplex*, *simplex* or *totum duplex* as the grade of a feast. Every hit for these words is ordinary Latin. The Bohemian Brethren's order for Posen (1576, Hussite) calls certain duties *duplicia* (double [duties]), and the Gottorf catechism (1571) teaches a *triplex usus legis* (threefold use of the law). Neither has anything to do with feasts. There are no abbreviations such as *dupl.* (double) or *semidupl.* (semidouble) either. *Festum fori* (Feast of the court) occurs only in a modern editor's note (on Nürnberg 1522). The medieval scale of Office grades did not pass into the evangelical church orders.

12.4.2 *Summum* and *minus summum*: grades of the chant

Summum survives, but as the name of a melody, not of a feast. In the late-medieval Kyriale the Kyrie and Gloria were sung to melodies graded by rank:

- *summum* (the highest [chant]) for the highest feasts, *minus summum* (the lesser summum) for lesser doubles;
- *paschale* (Easter [Kyrie]) for Eastertide, *dominicale* (Sunday [Kyrie]) for Sundays;
- *angelicum* (angelic [Kyrie]), *apostolicum* (apostles' [Kyrie]), *de martyribus* (of martyrs), *de confessoribus* (of confessors), *de virginibus* (of virgins) for saints' days;
- *feriale* for weekdays.

A number of Lutheran orders keep this system, and with it keep grading the day.

The Pomeranian order gives the grade of the Kyrie at Mass. **Pomerania, *Kirchenordnung*, 1542** (Sehling 4, p. 356):

Thereupon the *Kyrie dominicale*; or one may also sing upon the Sundays the *Kyrie angelicum*, *de martyribus*, or *confessoribus*, or *virginibus*, as they have been named; the *dominicale* in Advent and in Lent, the *paschale* between Whitsuntide and Easter, the *summum* upon the higher feasts, or else the *minus summum*.

Note. This is the clearest statement in the corpus of the old Kyrie grades applied by rank. The saints' melodies are now simply alternatives for ordinary Sundays. The *summum* is kept for "the higher feasts" (*die hohern fest*), and *minus summum* is offered as a lesser alternative there.

The Buxtehude *Agende* has these headings over its printed Kyrie melodies, which the editor traces to Lucas Lossius's *Psalmodia*. **Buxtehude, *Agende*, 1565** (Sehling 7/1, p. 123):

On the highest festivities and on the Sunday of the Trinity, with the text. *Minus summum* (the lesser summum). I. On the feasts of the blessed Virgin Mary. II. *Kyrie paschale* (Easter Kyrie). *Dominicale* (Sunday [Kyrie]). In the Advent of the Lord. *Kyrie angelicum*. *Kyrie apostolicum* (apostles' Kyrie). *Dominicale*.

At Hof the grades appear in the Latin school Mass in the monastery church. **Hof, *Ordo ecclesiasticus*, 1592** (Sehling 11, p. 472):

Straightway, secondly, is sung out of the great missal the Kyrie of the proper season: either the *angelicum* in the Advent of the Lord; or the Kyrie *Magnae Deus potentiae* (O God of great power) of the Nativity of Christ, whereunto the *Et in terra angelicum* (the angelic Et in terra) is joined; or the greater *dominicale* after the Sunday of Septuagesima until Easter; or the Kyrie *paschale*; or the Kyrie *Fons bonitatis* (Fount of goodness) with the *Et in terra angelicum*; or the lesser *dominicale* after the feast of the Trinity; or that *de apostolis* (of the apostles), *de martyribus*, etc., as the time requireth and the order of the book sheweth.

Note. At Hof the melodies are chiefly seasonal. Its German *Kirchenamt* still names them by rank all the same:

- The same Kyrie is called *angelicum seu feriale* (angelic or ferial) in Advent (p. 432).
- It is called *angelicum seu festivale* (angelic or festal) on St Laurence's day (p. 445) and on the feasts of Mary (p. 450).
- The *Benedicamus* at vespers is labelled *festivale*, *dominicale*, *paschale* or *feriale* (for example "Benedicamus festivale seu feriale" [festal or ferial Benedicamus], p. 422).

Nördlingen reserves the *summum* for Pentecost and Trinity. **Nördlingen, *Ordnung der ceremonien*, 1544** (Sehling 12, pp. 321–322):

At Whitsuntide. 1. The introit *de Spiritu* (of the Spirit), or *Kom, hailiger Gaist* (Come, Holy Ghost). 2. *Kyrie summum* and *Et in terra* (And on earth), as at Easter. […] Of the holy Trinity. 1. The introit *de tempore* (of the season). 2. *Kyrie summum* with the *Et in terra*. 3. After the epistle, the sequence *de tempore*.

In Mecklenburg the grade name passes to a German Kyrie. **Mecklenburg, *Ordeninge der misse*, 1545** (Sehling 5, p. 151):

The Dutch [that is, German] *Kyrie summum*, "Ah Father, God most high of all", shall the parsons in the villages sing, and teach it the people, that the whole church may sing it.

"The highest feasts" as a category. Outside the chant books, *summa festa* (highest feasts) or *summae festivitates* (highest festivities) is used simply as the name of the top rank of days.

The Hadersleben article on Latin singing. **Hadersleben, *Artikel*, 1528** (Sehling 23, p. 64):

It shall also be free that they may on the great feasts sing *Gloria in excelsis* in Latin, likewise the Alleluia and a sequence, as *Grates nunc omnes* (Let us all now give thanks), *Victimae paschali*, *Veni Sancte Spiritus* (Come, Holy Spirit), and the *Leisen* therein; item the Latin *Patrem* (the Nicene Creed), the prefaces, the Sanctus and the *Agnus Dei* (Lamb of God): yet that only upon the great feasts.

Note. In the Latin version of these articles, preserved in the edition's apparatus, this article is headed *De Latine cantionibus in summis festis* (Of Latin songs on the highest feasts). The Low German "groten feste" (great feasts) and the Latin *summa festa* are the same rank.

Tangermünde's *Ritus* (Rite) is a local custom-book, printed from Küster. **Tangermünde, *Ritus*, 1603** (Sehling 3, p. 338):

If the highest festivities come to be celebrated and are begun, the ministers shall rest from the labour of preaching from the Sunday through the whole week. 3. On the highest feasts the deacon that hath the morning sermon expoundeth the text of the Gospel, the pastor another that is convenient, the other deacon the lesson of the Epistle.

Gottorf, visitation articles, 1587 (Sehling 23, p. 371):

12. Whether the Preface, *Dominus vobiscum* (The Lord be with you), be sung on the highest feasts before the communion, and in what tongue.

12.4.3 Nine lessons and three

In the medieval Office, a feast of higher grade had a matins of three nocturns and nine lessons. A simple feast or a feria had one nocturn and three lessons. Luther's *Formula missae* (Form of the Mass) already takes the three-lesson matins as the norm for ordinary days.

Wittenberg, Luther, *Formula missae*, 1523 (Sehling 1, p. 9):

In the rest of the days, which we call ferias, I see nothing that may not be borne, so that the masses be abolished. For the matins of three lessons, and the hours, and also vespers and compline *de tempore* (of the season; the holy days of the saints being excepted), are nothing but the words of divine Scripture.

Pfalz-Neuburg still reckons with both forms in chapters and monasteries. **Pfalz-Neuburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1543** (Sehling 13, pp. 77–78 and 95):

These may be so ordered in the chapters and cloisters where matins is sung daily, that when nine lessons are kept, three be taken out of the historical books of the Bible, as Moses, Joshua, Judges, Ruth, Samuel, the Kings and Chronicles, […] thereafter three out of the prophets […] Likewise the three matins in the week of the Passion shall be kept at their wonted time, and also according to the instruction aforesaid, yet without all knocking, rumbling and tumult; only that where they are kept with nine lessons, the last three, or where they are kept with three lessons only, those same three, shall be read in German in the parish churches, and where the common people are present.

In Waldeck a high feast raises the village matins by one grade. **Waldeck, *Kirchenordnung*, 1556** (Sehling 9, p. 276):

Early, at matins, the scholars shall begin with the *Veni sancte*; next an invitatory and *Venite*, if it can be done; thereafter antiphon and psalms *de Dominica* (of the Sunday) or *de Festo* (of the feast); hereupon the lessons and responds of the common Sunday

and holy day, as above under the title "Church order in the villages"; but upon high feast days three lessons and responds, agreeable to the feast; next sing *Te Deum laudamus* (We praise thee, O God), *Benedictus* with its antiphon, the collects and *Benedicamus*.

In the Transylvanian order the more solemn feasts keep a fuller matins. **Transylvanian Saxons, *Kirchenordnung*, 1547** (Sehling 24, p. 222; Latin version):

But on the more solemn feasts three antiphons with their psalms are retained. […] These are followed by the *Te Deum laudamus* in German, on the greater feasts in Latin also.

12.4.4 Proper, common and *de tempore*

Where the Office was still sung in a chapter or convent, the orders use the old categories of the Office. These are the ferial, dominical and festal forms; the proper *de festo* (of the feast) against the *commune sanctorum* (common of the saints); the octave; and the *suffragia*.

Goslar, collegiate church of SS. Simon and Jude, *Ordnung für das Stundengebet*, 1534 (Sehling 7/2.2, p. 264):

Vespers. The ferial psalms with one *Gloria* and one antiphon; thereafter a lesson out of the New Testament, beginning at the beginning of Matthew, etc.; on a feast the respond of the feast; the hymn ferial, or dominical, or of the feast; *Magnificat* with the ferial antiphon, on Sunday the third antiphon out of the Sunday Gospel, on festivities of the feast; thereafter *Kyrie eleison, Christe eleison, Kyrie eleison*, *Pater noster*, the versicle *Ostende nobis, Domine, misericordiam tuam* (Show us thy mercy, O Lord), etc., the dominical or festal collect, *Benedicamus*.

Crevese, Benedictine nunnery, visitation recess, 1541 (Sehling 3, p. 203):

Otherwise also the maidens shall commonly keep the hours *de tempore* (of the season), and of the high feasts, as hitherto hath been done. Likewise, when a feast *de sanctis* (of the saints) cometh, they shall keep the *commune sanctorum*, and all these chants reformed, as they are sung in the chapter at Cölln on the Spree.

Note. Proper Offices are allowed for the high feasts. A saint's day gets only the common Office, which names no saint's legend. The same wording recurs in the other Brandenburg convent recesses (Sehling 3, pp. 219, 238, 272, 305).

At the Ansbach chapters saints' octaves and suffrages are forbidden. **Brandenburg-Ansbach, *Ordnung singens und lesens bei den Stiften*, 1533** (Sehling 11, p. 314):

All suffrages *de sanctis* they shall leave off, for they set trust in the saints against the first commandment of God. Only upon the working days they may keep the suffrages *pro pace* (for peace) and *pro peccatis* (for sins). Item, they shall also keep the octave, the eighth day, of no saint. The history of the Trinity is pure; that they may keep as they will.

Note. This is the only explicit ruling on octaves among the rank passages. Elsewhere octaves are never forbidden, but they are also simply never mentioned. The Lutheran "three days" of the high feasts (§12.7) took their place.

12.4.5 *Ferialiter*, *festive*, *solenniter*

Three adverbs from the old rubrics survive: *ferialiter* (in the ferial manner), *festive* (festally) and *solenniter* (solemnly). *Ferialiter* is used in two opposite senses:

- In Anhalt it keeps its medieval meaning: "in the weekday manner", without the *Gloria in excelsis*.
- In the county of Wied (Reformed) it means "as a holiday", from classical *feriae*.

Anhalt's order of the German hymns builds a three-step scale into the Mass:

- the high feasts, with sequence, *Patrem* (the Nicene Creed), preface, Sanctus and *Agnus Dei* (Lamb of God);
- other Sundays and holy days, with German hymns and Luther's exhortation;
- weekdays, *ferialiter*.

Anhalt, *Ordnung der deutschen Gesänge*, before February 1551 (Sehling 2, pp. 554–555):

on high feasts the Alleluia and sequence, on other Sundays or holy days a German hymn […] and then on high feasts let the priest sing the preface and the scholars the Sanctus. On other Sundays and holy days shall be read Doctor Martin Luther's exhortation to the communicants. […] But under the communion on high feasts shall be sung the *Agnus Dei* […] On the working days it shall be kept thus. In the morning a short matins shall be sung; but if there be communicants, such matins may be left off, and the whole office of the Supper kept in like measure and form as above shewed, yet *ferialiter*, as they call it, namely the Sunday introit or a German psalm, Kyrie eleison, but without *Gloria in excelsis*

Anhalt, *Kirchenordnung* of Prince Bernhard, 1568 (Sehling 2, p. 569):

But if the feast of the Annunciation fall in the week of the Passion, it shall be kept on the eve of Palm Sunday; the Visitation and the Nativity of Mary are to be kept *ferialiter*, with their wonted Gospels.

Note. The Visitation and Nativity of Mary are not holy days. Their Gospels are read on the day, in the weekday form. This is the only order in the corpus that keeps the Nativity of Mary in this reduced way. Compare §12.8.4.

Wied (Reformed) has a two-column list of feasts. **Wied, *Synodalbeschlüsse*, 1564** (Reformed; Sehling 19/1, p. 467):

There followeth the catalogue of feasts. *Ferialiter* [that is, to be kept as holidays]: of the Circumcision of Christ; of the Three Kings; of the Purification of Mary; of the Annunciation of Mary; of Matthias; of the Visitation of Mary; of Easter with the next day following; of the Ascension of Christ; of Pentecost with the day following; of John the Baptist […] the feast of the Nativity of Christ with the two days following; of all the Apostles. Only a sermon shall be held: on All Saints; the Conversion of Paul; Mark; Mary Magdalene; Laurence; the Nativity of Mary; the Beheading of John; Michael; Catherine; on the feasts of the patrons of every church.

Note. Sehling's editor reads the first column as the whole holy days and the second as the half holy days, kept by a morning sermon only. Two things stand out:

- **Michaelmas.** In the north it is one of the four chief feasts (§12.9). Here it is only a sermon day.
- **Patronal feasts.** The feast of each church's patron survives at the lowest grade. No other order in the corpus keeps it.

Amt Leisnig, *Verordnung der Visitatoren*, 1529 (Sehling 1, p. 610):

Also the three high feasts shall always be kept three days, solemnly and *festive*, with all ceremonies; and in all else they shall keep themselves obediently to the book, the Instruction of the Visitors.

12.4.6 Vigils and first vespers

The medieval vigil, with its fast and vigil office, disappears. What survives is the evening before a feast: first vespers, with confession for the next day's communicants and on the higher feasts a sermon. The name *vigilia* (vigil) survives with it. So does the old rule that only feasts of some rank have a proper eve.

Hof, *Ordo ecclesiasticus*, 1592 (Sehling 11, p. 411):

The order of chants at the evening prayers, and that in particular for all the days before feasts (the common people call them vigils), that is, the days next going before Sundays and feasts.

Lohr (county of Rieneck), *Vesperordnung*, 1588 (Sehling 11, p. 699):

Touching vespers, the same shall be rung and begun in summer-time at three of the clock, but in winter-time somewhat earlier as occasion serveth, after the ordering of the parsons; and *in vigiliis* or at the first vespers, that is, on the eve of the high and other feasts, Sundays and holy days (that the youth may be exercised in psalmody and plain-song, as is used in all churches), it shall be sung and kept with Latin psalms, responds, hymns, *Magnificat*, collects, versicles, *Benedicamus* and the rest, according to the order of the *Psalmodia* of L. Lossius […]

Burg has a sermon at vespers on the eve of the high feasts. **Burg, *Kirchen-Ordnung*, 1542** (Sehling 2, p. 427):

First, on all Saturdays, and *in vigiliis* of the high feasts and also of the other evangelical holy days, vespers shall be held in both parish churches by the parson or his deacon […] And if it be deemed needful and convenient, and in especial on the vigils of the high feasts, there shall be preaching also after vespers.

Bremen gives a list of thirteen feasts, from Sunday to Michaelmas, and then adds a rule. **Bremen, *Kirchenordnung*, 1561** (Sehling 7/2.2, p. 513):

9. The day of Pentecost, together with the two joined to it. 10. The day of the Trinity. 11. The day of John the Baptist. 12. The day of the Visitation of Mary. 13. The day of Michael. On the vigil and preparation of these feasts, about the second hour, let vespers be held by the whole Latin school in the church of the Blessed Virgin, singing one or two Latin psalms, the respond for the season, and the hymn *Magnificat*. But in the rest of the churches let it be sung in German.

Nicolaus Hausmann's order for Anhalt is the only order in the corpus that would like to keep the night vigil of Christmas and Easter. **Anhalt, Nicolaus Hausmann's order, 1532** (Sehling 2, p. 542):

The vigil of Easter; of the Nativity. It were also not evil that Christmas night and Easter were kept with the watch, as of old.

Note. Hausmann goes on to name the abuses that have grown up around the night watch. He proposes instead an early service at about three in the morning (p. 543).

12.5 The Lutheran scale of feasts

12.5.1 The common pattern

Most orders rank the feast days in the same few steps, though the words vary.

Rank	Names used in the orders	Usual days	How kept
Sunday	*der Sontag* (the Sunday), *des Herren Tag*, *dies dominica* (the Lord's day)	every Sunday	the whole day; the norm by which the feasts are measured
1. The high feasts	*hohe Feste* (high feasts), *Hauptfeste* (chief feasts), *heuptfest des herrn Christi*, *de dre groten feste Christi* (the three great feasts of Christ), *summa festa* (highest feasts), *Vierzeiten* (the four times), *große Feste* (great feasts)	Christmas, Easter, Whitsunday, each with one or two following days; often Michaelmas as the fourth; sometimes Ascension	the whole day, usually on two or three days; two or three sermons; Latin chant, sequence and proper preface; figural music; communion; no weddings
2. The other feasts of Christ and "Gospel" feasts	*die andern festa Christi* (the other feasts of Christ), *fürnembste Feste* (chiefest feasts), *andere herliche fest* (other glorious feasts), *gemeine fest* (common feasts), *mittelmeßige festa* (middling feasts)	Circumcision (New Year), Epiphany, Purification, Annunciation, Ascension, Trinity; John the Baptist, Visitation, Michaelmas; in some orders Maundy Thursday and Good Friday	usually the whole day, "as on Sundays", with the introit, sequence and preface *de tempore* (of the season); in some orders only the forenoon
3. Apostles' days and other saints' days	*Aposteltage* (apostles' days), *kleine Feste* (small feasts), *halbe Feiertage* (half holy days), *festa apostolorum* (apostles' feasts)	the apostles; the Conversion of Paul; often Mary Magdalene, the Beheading of John, All Saints	a sermon in the forenoon, work after it; or no holy day, with the Gospel preached on the next Sunday or at a weekday sermon
4. Abolished feasts	*papistische feste* (papist feasts), *abgötterische feste* (idolatrous feasts)	Corpus Christi, Holy Cross, the Conception, Nativity and Assumption of Mary (in most orders), All Souls, local saints	not kept; sometimes proclaimed and explained so that people know why they are gone

The orders differ in three ways:

- **How many ranks they draw.** Some have two, many three, and a few four.

- **Where the middle feasts stand.** John the Baptist, the Visitation, Michaelmas, and in some orders Purification and Annunciation, sit either with the feasts of Christ or with the apostles.
- **What a lower rank means.** It may mean a half holy day, a single sermon, a transfer to Sunday, or the loss of the holy day altogether.

The families below show the main lines.

12.5.2 The Saxon and Mecklenburg family: "over and above these chiefest feasts"

The line starts with the Saxon *Unterricht der Visitatoren* (Instruction of the Visitors) of 1528. It speaks of two ranks in its own words.

Saxony (Ernestine), *Unterricht der Visitatoren*, 1528 (Sehling 1, p. 164):

It were good also that they should keep holy day with one accord on the Sundays, the Annunciation, the Purification, the Visitation of the pure Virgin Mary, St John the Baptist, Michaelmas, the apostles', Magdalene; unless those feasts be already fallen away and could not conveniently all be set up again. And in especial one shall keep Christmas, the Circumcision, the Epiphany, the Easter holy days, the Ascension, Whitsuntide; yet with all things done away that are found therein of unchristian legends or chants.

In Albertine Saxony the feasts of Christ follow the preamble quoted in §12.3.7. Sehling gives this part of the order in his own summary but quotes the text. **Saxony (Albertine), *Kirchenordnung*, 1539** (Sehling 1, p. 274):

The day of the Nativity or birth of Christ, with the second and also the third next following, if there be communicants thereon. The day of the Circumcision of Christ. The day of the Epiphany, that is, of the appearing or manifestation of Christ, when the wise men from the east came to Christ by the appearing of the star; this day is also kept of the baptism of Christ. The day of the manifestation of Christ in the temple, which is called the Purification of Mary. The day of the Annunciation or Conception of Christ, when Christ was conceived in the Virgin's womb. The day of the Lord's Supper, which is called Maundy Thursday, whereon one is to preach of the Supper and the most worthy Sacrament. The day of the Passion of Christ, which is called Good Friday. Easter day, of the resurrection of the Lord, with the next following and the third, if there be communicants. The day of the Ascension of Christ. Whitsunday, of the sending of the Holy Ghost. The feast of the holy Trinity falleth on the next Sunday after Pentecost. Over and above these, these feasts also shall be kept: the day of St John the Baptist, to the honour of the holy office of preaching the Gospel of Christ; the day of the Visitation, when Mary visited her cousin Elisabeth, because of that history of the Gospel; the day of Michael, whereon one is to preach of the holy angels. […] One may also keep the days of the holy apostles, so that one preach thereon before noon and, if occasion serve, hold the communion. But in the afternoon one may well attend to the daily work; or, if one will, one may put over the Gospels and remembrance of the holy apostles to the next Sunday that followeth, to the midday or evening sermon. Likewise it may be done also with certain other feasts of the saints whose histories are written in the Gospel, as are St Paul's conversion, Mary Magdalene, St John's beheading, St Stephen, etc.

The Merseburg synodal instruction sets the two ranks side by side, and its title for the lower rank is a phrase worth noting: "yet without a commanded holy day". **Merseburg, *Synodalunterricht*, 1544** (Sehling 2, p. 20):

To keep holy day the whole day, and to preach before and after noon: all Sundays, and the following evangelical feasts: the Nativity of Christ with the second and also the third day, if there be communicants thereon […] Over and above these, these holy days shall be kept: the day of St John the Baptist, to the honour of the holy office of preaching the Gospel of Christ; the day of the Visitation, when the Virgin Mary visited her cousin Elisabeth, because of the fine history of the Gospel; the day of Michael, whereon to preach of the dear angels. On the following days preaching and communion, if it so fall out, shall be held before noon, and they shall be declared to the people on the Sunday before, yet without a commanded holy day: namely the day of the Lord's Supper, which is called Maundy Thursday, whereon to preach of the Supper and the most worthy Sacrament; the day of the Passion of Christ, which is called Good Friday, whereon the whole history of the Passion of Christ should be set forth to the people; the day of Peter and Paul and of all apostles, to the honour of the holy apostolic office

Note. Maundy Thursday and Good Friday stand in the lower rank here, beside the apostles. The feasts of Christ are placed by their standing as holy days, not by their theological weight.

The Mecklenburg order of 1552 is the fullest form of the Saxon scheme, and it is the one most often copied. **Mecklenburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1552** (Sehling 5, pp. 200–201):

Of the special feasts or holy days which shall be kept in the year. Over and above the common Sundays shall be kept the high chief feasts of the Lord Christ, which are these: the day of the Nativity or birth of Christ, with the second and third following; the day of the Circumcision of Christ; the day of the Epiphany, that is, of the appearing or manifestation of Christ, which is called the day of the Three Kings; the day of the offering of Christ in the temple, called the Purification of Mary; the day of the Annunciation of Mary or Conception of Christ, when Christ was conceived in the Virgin's womb; the day of the Lord's Supper, which is called Maundy Thursday, whereon shall be preached of the Lord's Supper; the day of the Passion of the Lord, or of the suffering and death of Christ, which is called Good Friday; Easter day, or Pascha, the day of the resurrection of Christ, with the Monday and Tuesday following; the day of the Ascension of Christ; Whitsunday, with the Monday and Tuesday following; the day of the Trinity falleth on the next Sunday after Pentecost. On these feasts it shall be done, as touching the order of lessons, chants, sermons and communion, as on the common Sundays; only that the introits, sequences and prefaces *de tempore* (of the season) be sung. […] Over and above these chiefest feasts these also shall be kept: the days of the apostles; the day of St John the Baptist; the day of the Visitation, when Mary visiteth her cousin Elisabeth; […] the day of Michael, whereon the doctrine of the holy angels shall be set forth to the people. On these days one shall preach before noon, and if there be communicants, hold the communion, as on Sundays; but in the afternoon one may well attend to the wonted work. Except the day of Michael, whereon there shall be preaching before and after noon. But the feast of the Assumption, or Ascension of Mary, shall henceforth be wholly done away, and in the stead of the same the feast of St Michael be kept as a feast of the four times.

Note. Michaelmas has a place of its own in this scheme:

- It is listed with the second rank, but it is preached "before and after noon" like a feast of Christ.
- It takes the Assumption's place as one of the four *Vierzeiten* (the four times; §12.9).

The Mecklenburg text, with small changes, stands in these orders:

Order	Sehling	Changes of note
Pfalz-Zweibrücken, *Kirchenordnung*, 1557	18, pp. 205–206	apostles' days not named one by one (listed in the *Feiertagsordnung* [holy-day order] of 1561, §12.6.2)
Lüneburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1564	6/1, pp. 550–551	follows Mecklenburg closely, including the prefaces *de tempore*
Wolfenbüttel, *Kirchenordnung*, 1569	6/1, pp. 151–152	"But on such apostles' days, after the sermon, every one may well attend to his work"; Corpus Christi explicitly abolished
Oldenburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1573	7/2.1, pp. 1096–1097	Michaelmas "in place of the feast of the Assumption or Ascension of Mary, as a four-times feast"; Te Deum for the harvest
Lüneburg (city), *Kirchenordnung*, 1575	6/1, pp. 660–661	as Lüneburg 1564
Lippe, *Kirchenordnung*, 1571	21, pp. 391–392	prefaces *de tempore* only "on the four-times feast days" (§12.9)
Verden, *Kirchenordnung*, 1606	7/1, p. 166	Trinity "hochfeyerlich"
Waldeck, *Kirchenordnung*, 1556	9, pp. 272–273	Michaelmas "for the fourth chief feast"; Good Friday "half kept until midday" (§12.6.1)
Kronstadt (Transylvania), *Agende*, 1547	24, p. 255	the list itself follows the Nürnberg model (§12.5.7, §12.8.3); the closing admonition is taken from the Saxon order of 1539/40

12.5.3 The Württemberg family: holy days proclaimed by the magistrate

The Württemberg orders make the magistrate's proclamation the mark of a holy day (§12.3.5). At first they drew only one clear line: the high feasts of Christ kept the whole day, and the rest kept only in the forenoon.

Württemberg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1536 (Sehling 16, pp. 105–106):

But in our principality the feasts and holy days following shall be kept: first all Sundays; item, all the high feasts of Christ, namely Christmas, the Circumcision, Easter day, Ascension day, Whitsunday. And these days also shall be kept without constraint, and no man's conscience burdened therewith [...] But further, all parsons shall preach in the morning on the days hereafter noted, and then shew the people that every man may betake himself to his work in the afternoon, and that herein no man shall be bound: namely on the day of the Three Kings or Twelfth Day, whereon shall be preached out of Matthew the second chapter; Maundy Thursday; Good Friday, when the Passion is preached; our Lady's Annunciation day; our Lady's Purification; all apostles' days; St John the Baptist's day.

The Württemberg list follows the preamble of §12.3.5. **Württemberg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1553** (Sehling 16, p. 266):

All Sundays. Christmas day. The next day after. New Year's day. Twelfth Day, called the Epiphany. Easter day with the next after. The Ascension of Christ. Whitsunday with the Monday following. Candlemas, the Purification of Mary. The Annunciation of Mary. All apostles' days. John the Baptist's.

Note. In 1553 every day on the list is a holy day, with no half days. The distinction came back in later orders of the family:

- **Pfalz-Zweibrücken 1561** added half days (§12.6.2).
- **Pfalz-Veldenz 1574** added half days as well (§12.6.2).
- **Baden 1603** has the same list but allows field-work after the morning service:

Baden, *Kirchenordnungsmandat*, 1603 (Sehling 16, p. 559):

The Sundays are to be kept holy altogether strictly, and all field-work and other labour to cease; likewise the ordinary feast days and apostles' days shall be kept holy in the forenoon without condition, and in the afternoon field-work shall be allowed only with discretion

12.5.4 The Bugenhagen family: "the three great feasts of Christ"

Bugenhagen's orders count feasts from the three great feasts of Christ. Each is kept three full days. The rest are "full" holy days for their Gospel histories. The apostles are commemorated on the next Sunday.

Braunschweig, *Kirchenordnung*, 1528 (Sehling 6/1, p. 397):

The three great feasts of Christ which the Christians have always kept, as Christmas, Easter and Whitsuntide, every feast to be fully kept holy three days, wherein there shall be preaching in the morning, before noon, after noon and at evening, and singing thereto, as shall be said hereafter. Thereto New Year's day, the Epiphany, that is the day of the manifestation or the Kings' day, the Purification, that is Mary's church-going, Mary's Annunciation, the Lord's Ascension, John the Baptist, Mary's going over the hills, to be fully kept holy; not for the days' sake, but for the preaching's sake, forasmuch as the histories are contained in the Gospels and concern our Lord Christ, etc. Item, Michaelmas for a feast of the four times, to offer the four-times offering into the common treasure-chest, also to be fully kept holy. [...] The memorials of the holy apostles, and of Magdalene, and of Laurence the holy chest-master or deacon, shall be laid upon the next Sunday after their calendar day; so that one shall diligently preach the Gospel of the Sunday as upon another Sunday, and take nothing at all from it; all chant and mass also shall be of the Sunday; only at the end of the sermon the preacher shall say: My friends in Christ, in this week it is wont to be remembered of the holy apostle N., of whom one readeth thus in the Gospel, in the Acts of the apostles, etc.

Note.

- **Why the apostles lost their holy day.** The editor records that Bugenhagen first meant to keep the apostles' days as feasts. He gave up the plan when it was objected that a town of craftsmen would then have too many holy days.
- **Hamburg 1529.** Hamburg has the same text (Sehling 5, p. 514).
- **Lübeck 1531.** Lübeck adds the list of the four times (§12.9).

Pomerania, *Kirchenordnung*, 1535 (Sehling 4, p. 343):

And that the histories of our dear Lord Jesus Christ be not forgotten, we will keep all the feasts of Christ: as Christmas three days, Easter three days, Whitsuntide three days; next thereafter the Circumcision, the Epiphany, the Purification, the Annunciation, the Ascension, the Trinity; John the Baptist, to preach of his conception, of his birth, of his preaching and office, and of his

beheading, for that feast also pertaineth to Christ, and the history is also written in the Gospels. The Visitation likewise. Item, we will also keep the feast of Michael, to preach of the angels out of holy Scripture.

The Schleswig-Holstein list follows the principle quoted in §12.3.3. **Schleswig-Holstein, *Kirchenordnung*, 1542** (Sehling 23, p. 95):

The three great feasts of Christ we keep holy each three days long, for the histories of Christ. Beside these we keep holy also the feast of the Circumcision, of the Epiphany, of the Purification and of the Annunciation of Mary. […] We keep holy also the feasts of the Ascension and of the Visitation […] Last of all the feast of John the Baptist, the feast of Michael for thanksgiving, and the feast of All Saints. The apostles' feasts one shall openly proclaim, and preach them, together with the feast of Magdalene and of Laurence, on the next following Sunday thereafter.

Note. The editor explains the "Feasts of the Ascension" as the Assumption of Mary, on 15 August. The Danish-Holstein order of 1542 is thus one of the few Lutheran orders that keeps the Assumption as a holy day (§12.8.3). The Kiel draft behind it follows the Danish *Ordinatio ecclesiastica* of 1537.

12.5.5 Numbered classes

Some orders number their ranks outright.

Grubenhagen names three classes, and gives each its reason. **Grubenhagen, *Kirchenordnung*, 1544** (Sehling 6/2, pp. 1032–1033):

VI. Of the holy days which shall be kept. The feast of the Nativity of Christ; St Stephen's day, of the first martyr; St John's day, of the evangelist; the day of the innocent children, while the sermon lasteth; the feast of the resurrection of Christ, the Monday and also the Tuesday; the feast of Pentecost, Whitsuntide, the Monday and also the Tuesday to be kept holy; the feast of Michael the archangel. These are therefore the four chief feasts, whereon the four-times penny is gathered. Now follow other glorious feasts, which shall also be kept holy: the feast of the Circumcision of the Lord; the feast of the Epiphany or of the Three Kings; the feast of the Purification of Mary; the feast of the Annunciation of Mary; the feast of the Visitation of Mary; the feast of the Ascension of Jesus Christ; the feast of St John the Baptist. These are therefore seven other feast days, which also are in the highest degree needful to be kept holy because of the histories. 1. St Andrew's day, 2. St Thomas's day, 3. St Matthias's day, 4. Maundy Thursday, 5. Good Friday, 6. St Philip and James's day, 7. St Peter and Paul's day, 8. St […] James's day, 9. St Bartholomew's day, 10. St Matthew the apostle's day, 11. St Simon and Jude's day. These days of the dear saints and disciples of our Lord Jesus Christ one shall be bound to keep holy in the forenoon only, while the office lasteth.

Note. The first class is defined partly by a church payment. The four chief feasts are the days on which the four-times penny is collected (§12.9). The Ascension stands in the second class, and Maundy Thursday and Good Friday in the third. The editor notes that this departs from the Wolfenbüttel order of 1543, which moved the apostles' days to the next Sunday.

Regensburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1567 (Sehling 13, p. 474):

[5.] Which feasts are kept holy in our church. Over and above the common Sundays are kept, with understanding of Christian liberty: first, all the feasts of Christ: the Nativity with the two days following, the Circumcision, the Epiphany, the Purification, the Annunciation, Easter day with the two days next following, the Ascension, Whitsunday with the two days following. Secondly are kept all the apostles' days. Thirdly: John the Baptist, Michael the archangel.

Note. Regensburg's numbering is an order of listing, not of dignity. Communion and first vespers, which mark the rank in this order, are given only "on each and every feast of Christ" (p. 475; see §12.10.9).

Hoya has four ranks, the fourth being the abolished Assumption. **Hoya, *Kirchenordnung*, 1571** (Sehling 6/2, p. 1186):

As touching the four high feasts, we ordain that Christmas, Easter and Whitsuntide, with the two days following, shall be rested, kept holy, and spent in the exercise of God's Word. But forasmuch as the feast of the Ascension of Mary was brought in by the Antichrist without ground and witness of Scripture, it shall hereby be wholly done away in our county, and no more be mentioned henceforth. But in the stead thereof we ordain the feast of St Michael, and will that the parishioners keep the day solemnly, and also render to their pastor on the same day their offering and due duty kindly and without hindrance. Secondly we ordain that the feasts and days hereafter written and set down shall in our lordship be wholly rested, kept holy and hallowed: as New Year's day, the day of the Three Kings, the feast of the Purification of Mary, the Annunciation of Mary, the Ascension of

Christ, John the Baptist's day, the Visitation of Mary, the day of the Lord's Supper, whereon one shall preach of the holy Supper, Good Friday […] Thirdly we ordain that the apostles' and saints' days hereafter set shall be kept holy until the sermon be ended: as Andrew, Thomas, the Conversion of Paul, Matthias, Peter and Paul, Philip and James, Magdalene, James, Bartholomew, the Beheading of John, Matthew, Simon and Jude, All Saints' day.

The Harlingerland order repeats Hoya's text, divided into titled *Sectiones*. **Harlingerland (East Frisia), *Kirchenordnung*, 1573/74** (Sehling 7/1, pp. 735–736):

The eleventh article. Of the feasts. Section the first. Of the four times. As touching the four high feast days, we ordain also that Christmas, Easter and Whitsuntide, with the two days following, shall be rested, kept holy and hallowed with the exercise of the divine Word. Of the Ascension of Mary. Forasmuch as that feast was set up by the Antichrist without ground and witness of the Scripture, it shall be wholly done away and not be mentioned. We ordain therefore that the last and fourth high feast-tide shall be St Michael's day. […] Section the second. Of the chiefest feast days. […] Section the third. Of the apostles' days. We ordain that the apostles' days underwritten shall be kept holy until the sermon be ended

Sayn has four classes, set out as a principle before the list. The margin heads the paragraph *Festa quadrupli* (feasts of four kinds). **Sayn, *Kirchenzuchtordnung*, 1582** (Sehling 19/1, p. 368):

And the feasts through the whole year might be divided into four kinds or several companies:

1. Some feasts are to be called chief feasts, which men shall keep holy solemnly the whole day, and whereon the common weekly work shall be left off. 2. The others are but middling feasts, which are kept half holy, in this wise and manner, that men come to church in the forenoon, hold and hear a sermon, but in the afternoon go on in the weekly work. 3. The third feast days may without hurt and offence be removed and taken up upon the common day of prayer, which otherwise is deputed and ordained in the week for preaching. 4. The fourth feast days, which were brought in and kept in the papacy for the confirming of open idolatry, shall in our evangelical churches be wholly done away and left off.

The list attached to it. **Sayn, *Kirchenzuchtordnung*, 1582** (Sehling 19/1, pp. 372–373):

Chief feasts, which shall be kept solemnly the whole day, and whereon the common weekly work shall be left off. The holy Christmas day. St Stephen's day. St John's day in the forenoon. New Year's day, before and after noon. The Epiphany of the Lord, or the day of the Three Kings. The Purification of Mary, or Candlemas. The Annunciation of Mary, or Conception of Christ; which feast, if it fall in the week of the Passion or after Easter, shall always be laid on the Saturday before Palm Sunday. Easter day with the two following, Monday and Tuesday. The day of the Ascension of Christ, throughout. Whitsunday and both the following, Monday and Tuesday in Whitsuntide. The feast of the holy Trinity, which followeth always eight days after Pentecost. […] The day of John the Baptist. St Michael's day, whereon men are wont to preach of the holy angels and to thank God for the good protection of the good spirits. The days following are kept but half holy, in this wise and manner, that men come to church before noon, hold and hear a sermon, but in the afternoon go on in the weekly work. All apostles' days shall be kept, when and as they fall in the year, yet only with one sermon in the forenoon, half holy. With the apostles' days shall be counted alike, and reckoned for half holy days: Maundy Thursday […] Good Friday […] St Paul's conversion day, for the excellent history's sake. The feast of Mary's Visitation. These days following, and the like, may be laid on the appointed days of prayer in the week: as St Laurence's day; St Mark the evangelist's; St Luke the evangelist's; […] Peter's Chains; the Beheading of John the Baptist; […] All Saints; Mary Magdalene's feast, for the sake of the fair text and history appointed to be handled thereon, that [they] may remain in remembrance. The days noted beneath shall be wholly done away and left off, as those that give occasion and furtherance to idolatry and superstition: all feasts of Mary, be their names what they will, which have not been named heretofore; but in especial the feasts of the Conception, Nativity, Presentation and Assumption of Mary shall in our evangelical churches be wholly taken up and be gone

Note. This is the fullest four-rank system in the corpus. The Sayn *Kirchenordnung* (church order) of 1590 (Sehling 19/1, p. 389) later reduced it to a single list of holy days, with the harvest apostles kept in the forenoon only (§12.6.4).

The Aschersleben town agenda has a middle rank of eight feasts over and above the three chief feasts. **Aschersleben, *Kirchen-Agenda*, 1575** (Sehling 2, p. 479):

Over and above the three chief feasts, these following shall also be kept in this Christian congregation: 1. The Circumcision of the Lord. 2. The Epiphany of the Lord. 3. The Purification of Mary. 4. The Annunciation of Mary. 5. The Ascension of the Lord. 6. John the Baptist. 7. The Visitation of Mary. 8. Michael. On these feasts it shall be done throughout as on Sundays; only that in singing

and preaching regard be had to the feast, and that figural music be used. […] Of the feasts of the apostles. Andrew, Thomas, Matthias, Philip and James, Peter and Paul, James, Bartholomew, Matthew, Simon and Jude: in our congregation there shall be held early a sermon and the office, before noon only. But the working people may each attend to his handiwork

12.5.6 Great feasts and small feasts: Danzig and Thorn

In Danzig the rank of a feast was marked above all by the bells (§12.10.7). The church fathers of St Mary's set down the custom in 1612. Article 16 lists every feast of the year as *ein gross fest* (a great feast) or *ein klein fest* (a small feast).

Danzig, St Mary's, *Kirchenordnung*, 1612 (Sehling 4, pp. 203–204):

Art. 14. Of chiming for the great feasts. When a great feast falleth, which is always kept with three sermons, then on the day before it is rung in the forenoon as is otherwise used on a day in the week. […] Art. 15. How one chimeth for the small feasts. For the small feasts, which are always kept with one sermon only, unless one of them fall on a Sunday, or be removed thither from the Sunday, then on the day before, in the afternoon, when it hath struck one, it is chimed with the Dominical and the Apostolica, and rung in with the Osanna; and this is called chiming with the Osanna […] Art. 16. The names of the great and small feasts, according to the course of the year, whereon one chimeth.

The Danzig list of 1612 (Art. 16, p. 204). It is condensed here from the two-column print. The first entry, a small feast before Epiphany, has lost its name in the digitized text.

Great feasts (*ein gross fest*)	Small feasts (*ein klein fest*)
Epiphany; Purification; Annunciation; Easter day, Easter Monday, Easter Tuesday ("with one sermon"); Ascension; Whitsunday, Whit Monday, Whit Tuesday ("with one sermon"); Trinity; Visitation ("with a sermon"); Christmas, St Stephen, St John the Evangelist ("with 1 sermon")	Matthias; Philip and James; John the Baptist; Peter and Paul; James; Bartholomew; Matthew; Michaelmas ("with 3 sermons … a small feast"); Simon and Jude; Andrew; Thomas

Two entries on the list are "no feast". The Dominicans' day (5 August) and St Laurence's day are rung with the great bell to open and close the town's market, and the list says of Laurence: "is no feast".

Thorn sets the same two ranks in prose, and also speaks of the "small or half feasts". **Thorn, *Kirchenordnung*, 1575** (Sehling 4, p. 239):

All the feasts of our Lord and Redeemer, namely the Nativity of Christ, the Circumcision, the Epiphany, the Purification, the Annunciation, the Supper of the Lord, the Preparation, Easter, the Ascension and Pentecost, shall be kept as well orderly as honourably, and with great earnestness and due reverence, for remembrance and admonition; in especial Christmas, Easter and Whitsuntide three days one after another: the first two days with three sermons, as otherwise on the Sunday; on the third day, where it fall not on a Sunday, with two sermons […] But touching the feasts or holy days of the Conversion of Paul, of John the Baptist, of the Visitation of Mary, of Michael, together with the twelve apostles' days, they shall be kept with two sermons […] but when such small or half feasts come upon a Sunday, the same may well be removed to the following day, namely to the Sunday [afternoon], and be kept at vespers.

Note. The sentence "on the following day, namely on the Sunday" is confused in the print. The meaning, as the next sentence shows, is that a small feast falling near a Sunday is handled at the Sunday vespers. Compare §12.14.

12.5.7 Wider calendars: the conservative orders

A number of orders keep much more than the pattern of §12.5.1. Some are early, and some come from princes who were cautious about change. They show where the Lutheran lists started from.

Brandenburg (Electorate), *Kirchenordnung* of Joachim II, 1540 (Sehling 3, p. 87):

There follow the feasts which, besides the Sundays, shall chiefly be kept and held holy in our lands. Namely: Christmas day. St Stephen's day. St John the Evangelist's day. New Year's day, or the Circumcision of the Lord. The day of the Three Kings. The day of the Purification of Mary. The day of Matthias the apostle. The day of the Annunciation of Mary. Easter day. Easter Monday. The day of Philip and James. The Ascension of the Lord. Whitsunday. Monday. Tuesday. Trinity Sunday. The day of Corpus Christi. The day of John the Baptist. The day of Peter and Paul. The day of the Visitation of Mary. The day of Mary Magdalene. The day of

James. The day of the Assumption of Mary. The day of Bartholomew. The day of the Nativity of Mary. The day of Matthew the apostle. The day of Simon and Jude. All Saints' day. St Martin's day. St Andrew's day. St Laurence's day. St Michael's day.

Note. The list goes on with Catherine and Thomas. It is a single rank that keeps Corpus Christi, the Assumption, the Nativity of Mary, All Saints, Martin, Laurence and Catherine. It matches the conservative character of the Brandenburg order as a whole.

Hausmann's Anhalt order has an early, one-rank list with the apostles already reduced to the forenoon. **Anhalt, Nicolaus Hausmann's order, 1532** (Sehling 2, p. 542):

The feasts in the year shall be kept free, for the exercise of faith, that the young and rude people may be at leisure to come to the sermon [...] and they are these by name: the Nativity of Christ with two days; New Year, the Circumcision; the Epiphany, which is called Three Kings; the Purification of Christ and of Mary; the Annunciation of Christ; Pascha with two days, Easter; the Ascension, the ascending of Christ; Pentecost, Whitsuntide with two days; Corpus Christi, the day of the holy true Body; John the Baptist; the Visitation, the Conception of Mary; Magdalene; Mary; Laurence; the Assumption; the Nativity; Michael; All Saints; Martin; all apostles' days in the forenoon.

The editor places the Pfalz-Neuburg list between Brandenburg 1540 and Brandenburg-Nürnberg 1533. **Pfalz-Neuburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1543** (Sehling 13, p. 94):

so will we that these following feasts and holy days be yet kept and held holy, as of old; yet so that the other days of the remembrance of Christ, and of the right and true saints who have sure witness in holy Scripture or otherwise of their Christian faith, life, miracles, suffering and blessed departing, be not taken away nor put in forgetfulness, but let remain unhallowed in remembrance, as of old. The feasts that shall be kept holy: New Year's day, called the Circumcision; Twelfth Day, called the Epiphany; Candlemas, called the Purification of Mary; Matthias the twelve-messenger; the Annunciation, called the Annunciation of Mary; Palm Sunday; Easter day with the Monday and the Tuesday after; Philip and James the twelve-messengers; Ascension day, called the Ascension of the Lord; Whitsunday with the Monday and the Tuesday after; the Holy Trinity, called Trinity; John the Baptist; Peter and Paul the twelve-messengers; James the twelve-messenger; our Lady's departing, called the Assumption

Note. This order makes a second rank of its own: days that are "unhallowed in remembrance" (*ungefeiret in gedechtnus*). Their memory is kept, but they are not holy days.

Nassau-Dillenburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1537 (Sehling 10, p. 74). This order keeps Corpus Christi, as a day to teach the right use of the Sacrament, and keeps the Assumption and the Nativity of Mary. The summer feasts are moved to Sunday for the harvest (§12.6.4, §12.8.9).

The Teschen list is one of the longest in the corpus. **Teschen, *Kirchenordnung*, 1584** (Sehling 3, p. 461):

IX. Which feasts shall be kept. Over and above the common Sundays shall be kept and solemnly celebrated the high chief feasts of our Christian faith, that the same may be diligently set forth and imprinted on the common people: namely the day of the Nativity of Christ with the second and third feast; the day of the Circumcision of the Lord; the Epiphany; the Conversion of Paul; the Purification of Mary; Matthias the apostle; the Annunciation of Mary; Maundy Thursday; Good Friday; Easter day with the following and third feast; Philip and James; the Ascension of Christ; Whitsuntide with the following holy days; thereafter the holy Trinity; the Nativity of Mary; John the Baptist; Peter and Paul; the Visitation of Mary; Mary Magdalene; James the apostle; the Transfiguration of the Lord; Bartholomew the apostle; the Beheading of John; Matthew; Michael the archangel; Simon and Jude; Andrew the apostle; Martin and Catherine. On these aforesaid feasts one may, as the season serveth, sometimes keep holy the forenoon only, and in the afternoon every man attend again to his calling and handiwork

Note. Every day in Teschen is formally a "high chief feast". The real ranking is left to the season: in time of work any of them may be a half day.

Weißenburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1528 (Sehling 11, p. 662):

But the chiefest feasts and holy days should be these: all Sundays; all the apostles' days; Christmas, together with St Stephen's day and St John's day, kept holy therefor and in one day; New Year's day; the Three Kings' day; Mary's Candlemas or Purification; Mary's Annunciation; Easter and the Monday after; the Ascension of Christ; Whitsunday and the Monday after; John the Baptist; Mary's Visitation; Mary's Assumption; Mary Magdalene; St Michael; and All Saints' day.

12.6 Whole holy days and half holy days

In practice the most important mark of rank was civil: whether a day was a holy day for the whole of it, for the forenoon only, or not at all. Many orders give the working population this information in the form of a list of "whole" and "half" days, to be declared from the pulpit on the Sunday before. The half holy day, kept "until noon" or "until the sermon is ended", is the Lutheran successor of the late-medieval distinction between *festa fori* (feasts of the court) and lesser feasts. It is also the chief place where economic pressure (harvest, markets, craftsmen's work) shaped the calendar.

12.6.1 The half holy day: "until noon"

The form appears as early as Nicolaus Hausmann's Anhalt order of 1532, with "all apostles' days in the forenoon" (§12.5.7). It is then fixed by the Saxon order of 1539 and by Mecklenburg 1552 (both in §12.5.2): a sermon in the forenoon, communion if there are communicants, and work after noon. Other examples:

Prussia, *Kirchenordnung und Ceremonien*, 1568 (Sehling 4, p. 87):

The apostles' days shall henceforth also be kept holy, but only in the forenoon, and the parishioners be reminded and instructed, in the appointed Gospels, of the old true apostolic doctrine, and also of the holy apostles' faith and good example [...] When the sermon hath been held and the holy Supper (in so far as there be communicants) celebrated, every man shall be free to work on these days in the afternoon. But the parsons shall always, on the next Sunday before, proclaim and shew the feasts and apostles' days, on what day in the week the same fall, and that the apostles' day shall be kept holy no longer than the forenoon, that every householder may order himself thereafter, etc.

The city of Osnabrück had sermons five times a week, and so needed "no special holy days". **Osnabrück (city), *Kirchenordnung*, 1543** (Sehling 7/1, p. 259):

Now forasmuch as there is preaching five times in the week beside the Sunday sermons, we need no special holy days, that we give not the common people occasion to go idle, and to go into the taverns, and to spend the time unprofitably, etc. Neither shall any feast or holy day be kept save only that men may hear God's Word preached, and pray to God and thank him for his grace through Christ. The apostles' days shall be kept holy until noon.

In Waldeck the half day extends even to Good Friday. **Waldeck, *Kirchenordnung*, 1556** (Sehling 9, pp. 272–273):

the day of the Passion of Christ, which is called Good Friday, shall be kept half holy until noon, but in the evening the burial of Christ shall be handled [...] These holy days aforewritten, beside those excepted, shall be kept holy wholly and throughout, and be proclaimed to the people always on the Sunday before [...] St Peter and Paul's, St James's and St Bartholomew's day one shall keep holy before noon, make the people a sermon, and thereafter let them go to their work

Note. Waldeck's text is printed by the editor with a second recension set into the apparatus, and the two are not always easy to separate. In the other recension Michaelmas is kept "as the fourth chief feast" (p. 272).

12.6.2 Tables of whole and half holy days

From the 1560s the orders of the Harz counties and of the Rhine and Main set out the whole and half days in formal lists.

Mansfeld, *Kirchen-agenda*, 1580 (Sehling 2, pp. 239–240):

Of common feasts. Forasmuch also as much disorder ariseth from the unequal keeping of the feast days, the parsons shall know which holy days in this county are kept wholly, and which but half. These feasts following are kept holy the whole day throughout: Christmas day, together with the two days following, Stephen and John; New Year's day; the day of the manifestation of Christ, which is called the day of the Three Kings; the day of the Purification of Mary; the day of the Annunciation of Mary; Easter day, with the two days following; the day of the Ascension of Christ; the day of holy Whitsuntide, with the two days next following; the day of John the Baptist; the day of the Visitation of Mary; the day of Michael. [...] The days following are kept but half holy: the day of St Andrew; the day of the apostle St Thomas; the day of the conversion of St Paul; the day of the apostle Matthias; Maundy Thursday; Good Friday; the day of Philip and James; the day of Peter and Paul; St James's day; St Laurence's day; the day of Bartholomew; the day of Matthew; the day of Simon and Jude.

At Wintzingerode the whole days (the same list as Mansfeld) are graded again by sermons. **Wintzingerode (Gericht Bodenstein), *Kirchen-Ordnung*** (Sehling 2, p. 256; after the Hohnstein order; undated):

And on every such day there shall be preaching twice, and rest kept from all manner of work the same whole day. On the third day of the three chief feasts, as on St John's day in holy Christmas, and on the Easter and Whitsun Tuesday, there shall be preaching but once. The days following are kept but half holy: the day of the apostle St Andrew; the day of the apostle St Thomas; the day of the conversion of St Paul; the day of the apostle St Matthias; Maundy Thursday; Good Friday; the day of Philip and James; the day of Peter and Paul; the day of Mary Magdalene; the day of St James; the day of Bartholomew; the day of Matthew; the day of Simon and Jude. […] Also the feasts and apostles' days shall always be proclaimed and bidden on the Sunday before, that the people may order themselves thereafter, and withal it shall be declared which shall be kept wholly and which half.

In Pfalz-Zweibrücken the duchy's *Statthalter* and councillors clarify the church order of 1557, which had been read in different ways. **Pfalz-Zweibrücken, *Feiertagsordnung*, 1561** (Sehling 18, pp. 297–298):

Namely thus: that henceforth the holy days following are to be kept for high feasts, which shall be kept holy like the Sundays before and after noon, to wit: […] 1. The Nativity, that is, Christmas day. 2. The Circumcision, the circumcising of Christ. 3. The Epiphany, that is, the holy Three Kings' day. 4. The Purification, that is, the day of the offering of Christ. 5. The Annunciation, the day whereon Christ was conceived in the Virgin's womb. 6. The Supper of the Lord, Maundy Thursday. 7. The Passion of the Lord, Good Friday. 8. The Ascension of the Lord, that is, Christ's going up to heaven. But as touching the other common holy days, which are the apostles' days, namely St Matthias, Philip and James, Peter and Paul, […] Andrew's and Thomas's day, item St John's day, the Visitation of Mary, St Michael's day […] and the two following after Christmas, Easter and Whitsuntide: on these God's Word shall henceforth be proclaimed only in the morning before noon. Yet in such wise that on such days before noon no man be suffered, on pain of ten gulden, to begin field-work or other work, nor to open his booth or shop, or to handle any such thing, until the sermon be done. But after the sermon is done, no man shall be compelled to keep holy, but every man shall then be free to work.

Note. Easter and Whitsunday fall on Sundays and are not listed. The second and third days of Christmas, Easter and Whitsuntide are half days here. So are John the Baptist, the Visitation and Michaelmas, which Mecklenburg had kept whole or nearly so.

In the Landau ordinance the "whole" days are only four, and they are called high feasts of Christ. **Landau, *Feiertagsordnung* of the town council, 1562** (Sehling 19/1, p. 61):

And these are the high feasts of the Lord Christ which shall be kept holy throughout like the Sunday: first, the day of the Nativity or birth of Christ, with the second day following; the day of the Circumcision of Christ; the day of the Epiphany, that is, of the appearing or manifestation of Christ, which is called the holy Three Kings' day; each Monday after Easter and Whitsuntide. Other holy days, which shall be kept only until noon: the day of the offering of Christ, called the Purification of Mary; the day of the Annunciation of Mary or Conception of Christ; the day of the Lord's Supper, called Maundy Thursday, whereon is preached of the Lord's Supper; […] the day of the Passion of the Lord, or of the suffering and death of Christ, called Good Friday; the day of the Ascension of Christ; item the days of the apostles; the day of St John the Baptist; the day of the Visitation of Mary; the day of Michael, because of the doctrine of the holy angels. And on such apostles' and holy days, beside the Sundays and the high feasts here mentioned, every burgher may well do his business and work after noon, as it serveth him.

Note. In Landau even the Ascension is a half day. The high feasts that fall on weekdays, Christmas, New Year and Epiphany, are whole days. So are the Mondays of Easter and Whitsuntide.

The Pfalz-Veldenz chapter is headed "[X.] Order of the holy days. [1. Half and whole holy days]". It gives a reason for keeping the half days. **Pfalz-Veldenz, *Kirchenordnung*, 1574** (Sehling 18, p. 518):

yet it is not advisable to change or abolish the accustomed holy days, since they serve the common Church to this end, that it may know appointed times, and be moved to resort to the sermon and the administration of the sacraments; for otherwise (as experience sheweth) the people are very slack and negligent at the week-day sermons, when they are suffered to work. Besides, it is needful that certain common days of prayer be kept in the year for the whole people, for which the appointed half holy days may be most convenient, if they be kept without superstition. Nor were it profitable to begin again to keep these days wholly; for (as we see) the abuse of holy days is very great: very few resort to the midday sermons, but they are rather spent in dancing, playing, carousing and other light things. Therefore the days which hitherto have been kept wholly or half shall be kept so henceforth according to this order; for herein it is needless to lead the people astray once more.

The list itself makes the half days into days of prayer. **Pfalz-Veldenz, *Kirchenordnung*, 1574** (Sehling 18, p. 519):

Item the two days following after Christmas, two after Easter and two after Whitsuntide. On these days one shall preach before noon only, and, if there be communicants, after the sermon one shall sing or read the Litany; for these days shall be proclaimed and kept for common days of prayer for the people.

Note. The whole days here are Christmas, Circumcision, Epiphany, Purification, Annunciation, Maundy Thursday and Ascension. The half days are the apostles, Good Friday, John the Baptist, the Visitation, Michaelmas, and the second and third days of the three great feasts. Like Waldeck 1556 (§12.6.1), this order ranks Good Friday below Maundy Thursday.

The Ysenburg-Ronneburg list grades each day separately, by sermons, forenoon and afternoon. **Ysenburg-Ronneburg, *Agende*, 1582** (Sehling 10, p. 583):

The feast of the Circumcision of Christ [...] which is otherwise called New Year's day, shall be kept holy and held wholly. The Epiphany of the Lord, or the Three Kings, shall also be kept holy before and after noon with a sermon. The Purification of Mary shall be kept holy the half day. The day of Matthias the apostle also but half a day. The Annunciation of Mary shall be kept the half day. Note: because this feast sometimes falleth in Holy Week, it shall then be passed over. Maundy Thursday and Good Friday shall each be kept before noon only. Easter day and Easter Monday shall both be furnished with sermons before and after noon; Easter Tuesday before noon only.

The list continues with the summer days, which are fitted to the harvest and to the market at Gelnhausen. **Ysenburg-Ronneburg, *Agende*, 1582** (Sehling 10, p. 583):

The day of John the Baptist, because of the market day at Gelnhausen, shall be celebrated only before noon with a sermon. [...] Peter and Paul and the day of the Visitation of Mary commonly fall in one week and in harvest-time; then of the two, the one that is most convenient shall be kept with a sermon before noon. Bartholomew, Matthew, Michael, Simon and Jude, St Thomas, these shall be kept only before noon. Christmas day and St Stephen's day shall be performed with sermons before and after noon. But St John the Evangelist's day may be concluded with one sermon only before noon.

The Nassau-Weilburg text of 1576 lists twelve feasts, and in 1618 a sentence was added to divide them. **Nassau-Weilburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1576, with the *Agende* of 1618** (Sehling 10, p. 228):

These holy days, which are ordained for the remembrance of the benefits of our Lord Jesus Christ, are kept with chant, sermons and communion like the common Sundays; only that the introits, sequences and other chants *de tempore* (of the season) are used instead of the other common chants. But the apostles' days shall all be kept with one sermon.

The 1618 *Agende* reads instead. **Nassau-Weilburg, *Agende*, 1618** (Sehling 10, p. 228; in the editor's apparatus):

celebrated like the common Sundays and wholly solemnly. But the third day at Christmas, Easter and Whitsuntide, together with the day of the Visitation of Mary, of St John the Baptist, and also Michaelmas and the holy apostles' days, shall be kept with one sermon, and the people go again to their work after noon. But that the common people may the better order themselves thereafter, our ministers shall always on the Sunday before proclaim from the pulpit what feasts and holy days fall in the same coming week, and whether they shall be kept half with one sermon, or wholly solemnly, according to the church order.

The Nassau-Weilburg rule in its final form. **Nassau-Weilburg, *Visitationsabschied*, 1609** (Sehling 10, p. 352):

Of holy days and week-day sermons. 1. We will and ordain that henceforth the whole holy days be kept with two sermons and other divine exercises; the third day in the Christmas, Easter and Whitsun holy days with one sermon; as also the day of John the Baptist, of the Visitation of Mary, and of Michael, like the apostles' days, half solemnly; and that the people go to their work after noon, when the divine service is performed. [...] 3. Where it is wont to celebrate the Lord's Supper on Maundy Thursday, *which is the day of the institution of the Lord's Supper*, we let it remain so; otherwise the same, together with Good Friday, shall be kept but half solemnly

Ritzebüttel has a Low German list in two columns. **Ritzebüttel, *Kirchenordnung*, 1556** (Sehling 5, p. 559):

But the holy days whereon our divine service is held in the church are these hereafter written, and are holy the whole day: all Sundays; the first two days in Christmas; New Year's day; the first two days in holy Whitsuntide; the Three Kings' day; item St John the Baptist's day; Mary's going over the hills; St Michael's day; Candlemas day; Mary's message; the first two days in holy Easter; the Lord's Ascension. The days hereafter noted are kept holy for the half day, or until noon, for the sermon's sake, thus: all apostles' days; the Tuesday in Easter; [the Tuesday in] Whitsuntide; Mary Magdalene's day; St Paul's conversion day; All Saints' day.

Solms-Laubach, *Kirchenzuchtordnung*, 1603 (Sehling 9, p. 356):

Of the holy days, chapter 1. The days following shall be kept holy the whole day, and no outward gross work be done thereon, but they be spent with preaching, singing, praying, reading and meditating of God's Word: all Sundays; the day of the birth of Christ with two days following; New Year's day, or the Circumcision; the day of the Epiphany […] the day of the offering of Christ in the temple, called the Purification of Mary; the day of the Annunciation of Mary or Conception of Christ […] the day of the Lord's Supper […] the day of the Passion of Christ […] Easter day and the resurrection of the Lord Christ, with the following Monday and Tuesday, […] the day of the Ascension, or of Christ's going up to heaven; Whitsunday with the following Monday and Tuesday. Beside these the days following shall be kept holy in the forenoon, and preaching held thereon: all apostles' days, St John the Baptist's day, the Visitation of Mary

Leiningen-Hardenburg, *Kirchenordnungsmandat* for Dürkheim, 1584 (Sehling 19/1, pp. 277–278):

Whereas it is provided in our church order that all Sundays and high feast days, as the holy Easter, Whitsun and Christmas day, together with the next day following, likewise also New Year's day, the holy Three Kings' day, Mary's Candlemas, Mary's Annunciation and the Ascension of Christ […] shall be kept holy and hallowed the whole day throughout, and God's Word be proclaimed and preached before and after noon […] But as touching the holy apostles' days, these shall be kept and hallowed in the forenoon with the proclaiming of God's Word; but after the sermon is ended every man may go to his work.

In the city of Osnabrück a local day of penance stands among the half days. **Osnabrück (city), *Kirchenordnung*, 1613** (Sehling 7/1, p. 267):

The days following are kept but half holy, with one sermon: 1. St John the Evangelist's day. 2. The day of the Purification of Mary. 3. The day of Matthias the apostle. 4. The eleventh day of March, whereon a sermon of repentance is held because of the damage by fire suffered on the 11th of March in the year 1613. Item Easter Tuesday and Whitsun Tuesday. 5. The day of the Annunciation of Mary. 6. The day of Philip and James. 7. The day of John the Baptist. 8. The day of Peter and Paul. 9. The day of the Visitation of Mary. 10. The day of James the apostle. 11. The day of Bartholomew, which is a day of thanksgiving for the fruits gathered in. 12. The day of Matthew. 13. The day of Simon and Jude. 14. The day of Andrew.

Note. In Osnabrück St Bartholomew's day, not Michaelmas, is the harvest thanksgiving. The sentence before this list puts St Stephen's day among the days "kept wholly, with two sermons only". The editor explains that the chief feasts had three: the catechism sermon, the chief (Gospel) sermon and the Epistle sermon.

At Tecklenburg the half day is defined by the sermon alone. **Tecklenburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1543** (Sehling 22, p. 245):

On these apostles' and other small feast days no man shall work during the sermon; to work before or after it shall be free.

A town's report to the visitors gives the rule in two lines. **Ermsleben, *Kirchen-Ordnung*, 1564** (Sehling 2, p. 486):

On all apostles' days there is preaching, and holy day is kept before noon. On the high feast days holy day is kept the whole day, and there is preaching twice.

Brieg is a Silesian order in which the three Marian feasts of Christ, with John the Baptist and Michaelmas, are whole days. **Brieg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1592** (Sehling 3, p. 445):

The three feasts of Mary, as the Annunciation, the Visitation and the Purification, item the feast of John the Baptist and of Michael, shall be kept solemnly the whole day, as they fall; but the apostles' feasts with one sermon, which shall be held early, yet so that the people can come to church.

12.6.3 Counting the rank in sermons

Many orders measure a day by its number of sermons: three, two, or one. At Penig the second day of a high feast has two sermons and the last day one.

Penig, *Kirchenordnung*, 1575 (Sehling 1, p. 634):

On all high feasts there are three sermons on the first day, at the times of matins, the office and vespers; on the following feast day two; on the last, one.

In Henneberg the four chief feasts have two sermons and all other feasts one. The Ascension is one of the four. **Henneberg, *Kirchenordnung* of Georg Ernst, 1582** (Sehling 2, pp. 312–313):

Of the feasts. Over and above the Sundays, for the considering of the benefits of Jesus Christ, our beloved Lord and Saviour, these feast days following shall be kept solemnly, and thereon the wonted Gospels handled with the ceremonies as ordained on the Sundays. First, the four chief feasts, with two sermons, before and after noon, as: the first and second Christmas day; the first and second Easter day; Ascension day; the first and second Whitsunday. Likewise also the Circumcision, the Three Kings, the Purification or Candlemas. Secondly the wonted other feasts, as: all apostles' days; item St Paul's conversion; the Annunciation; Thursday and Friday in Palm week; John the Baptist; the Visitation; Mary Magdalene; Michael, of the angels. All these shall first be proclaimed on the Sunday before, and thereafter, when and as they fall, […] be kept in manner following with one sermon. […] And then on the following morning it shall be kept with the ceremonies as on the common Sundays, yet without the organs. And when such sermon is performed before noon, every man shall go to his due work and calling.

Note. In Henneberg the Annunciation is a lower-rank feast, but the Circumcision, Epiphany and Purification go with the chief feasts. Also on the lower feasts the organ is silent.

12.6.4 Harvest, markets and the working year

The rank of the summer feasts was often cut down because of the harvest. The feasts of Peter and Paul (29 June), the Visitation (2 July), James (25 July), Mary Magdalene (22 July), Laurence (10 August), the Assumption (15 August) and Bartholomew (24 August) are the ones most affected.

The Mediasch synod gives the only technical term for the half day in the corpus, *intercise*. **Transylvanian Saxons, Mediasch synod, 1578** (Sehling 24, pp. 427–428; the report printed in the apparatus from Teutsch's *Urkundenbuch*):

In this synod, by the deliberation of certain pastors, two feasts of the apostles, of Peter and Paul and of St James, were removed because of the country works which everywhere fall in that month; and, it being disputed of the celebration of the other feasts dedicated to the apostles, it was concluded that these apostolic days should be held holy *intercise*, that is, by halves, and that after the morning office it be granted and free to every man to do handiwork; but the days of our Lord Jesus Christ, as the Annunciation, the Ascension, Easter, Pentecost, the Nativity, wholly.

Note. *Intercisi dies* was the Roman calendar's term for days that were holy in the morning and evening but lawful for business in between.

The Burzenland article is headed *De feriis hebdomadatibus* (Of the weekday holidays). **Burzenland (Transylvania), *Visitationsartikel*, 1578** (Sehling 24, p. 452; German version B in the apparatus):

Concerning the common holy days of the week, it is ordained by the spiritual university that they shall all be proclaimed from the pulpit. Yet because of the former abuse they shall be kept holy only until noon, with the handling of God's Word and the holy sacraments. Thereafter every man may attend to his own and the common work.

Note. The Latin note in the same apparatus records how the article went: it had been abolished "so that no saint's feast was celebrated", and was brought back at the synod of Birthälm in 1580.

In Mansfeld the apostles' Gospels in the harvest are moved to the Sunday, but only in the villages. **Mansfeld, *Kirchen-agenda*, 1580** (Sehling 2, p. 240):

But forasmuch as the days of Peter and Paul and of James fall in the harvest-time, and the people are loath at that time to be hindered at their work, the Gospels of the said days may in the villages be laid, each one, on the next following Sunday. But in the towns one may keep them on the day whereon they fall or come; if they come on a Saturday, they may also be transferred to the next Sunday.

Nassau-Dillenburg moves the whole block of summer feasts to Sunday. **Nassau-Dillenburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1537** (Sehling 10, p. 74):

St John the Baptist's day; item St Peter and Paul; Mary's Visitation, called *visitationis* (of the Visitation); St Mary Magdalene's day; St James the apostle's; St Laurence; the day of Mary's Assumption. All these, because they come in the very harvest, shall be kept on the next Sunday after the calendar day, unless they fall on the Sunday. And every parson shall, on the Sundays to which the

said holy days are removed, preach after noon, before the catechising of the children, the Gospel appointed to be kept for that day.

Sayn, *Kirchenordnung*, 1590 (Sehling 19/1, p. 389):

The day of Peter and Paul. The day of the Visitation of Mary. The day of James the apostle. The day of Bartholomew. Because the said apostles' feasts fall in the harvest, they shall be kept holy before noon only.

To avoid too many summer holy days, Veit Dietrich moves the Visitation to 15 August, where it takes the place of the Assumption. **Nürnberg, Veit Dietrich, *Agendbüchlein*, 1545** (Sehling 11, p. 538):

But since the feast of the Visitation of Mary commonly falleth in one week with St Peter and Paul, and the holy days would be too many at that time because of the field-work, it is thus devised that the same feast of the Visitation of Mary be put off to the fifteenth day of August, whereon otherwise the feast of the Ascension of Mary is kept, which yet hath no ground in the Scripture and hath given much occasion to great idolatry. Therefore on that day of the Assumption one shall hold the history of the Visitation, which is grounded in the Scripture and can therefore give a profitable doctrine.

Note. The same text is repeated in Hohenlohe 1578 (Sehling 15, p. 296), Wolfstein 1574 (Sehling 13, p. 587) and a Schwäbisch Hall draft of 1614 (Sehling 17/1, p. 191).

12.7 How many days: the high feasts and their following days

The late-medieval octave, a week-long observance of a great feast, has left almost no trace. Its place is taken by the "following days" (*nachfolgende Tage*, *Feiertage*) of Christmas, Easter and Whitsuntide. How many of them are kept, and how fully, is itself a mark of rank.

- **Three days** in all the Bugenhagen orders (§12.5.4), in Saxony, Mecklenburg and their successors (§12.5.2), and in Regensburg, Thorn, Danzig, the Harz counties and Schwarzburg.
- **Two days** (the feast and the next day) in the Württemberg family (§12.5.3), in the Brandenburg-Nürnberg order of 1533 and its successors (§12.8.3), and in Kurpfalz.
- **A graded third day**: the third day is still a holy day but with fewer sermons, no communion, or no figural music.

12.7.1 Three days

Amt Grimma, *Generalia der dorfer*, 1529 (Sehling 1, p. 576):

The high feasts shall always be kept three days, wholly solemnly, with preaching and other ceremonies, and in the masses, where there are communicants, the mass vestment be used.

Schwarzburg, *Ordnung der fest und feiertage*, 1587 (Sehling 2, p. 137):

The three chief feasts, Christmas, Easter and Whitsuntide, shall be kept solemnly three days: the first two days before and after noon, but the third in the forenoon only, with sermons; and where there be communicants, the office shall be held on all three days. Likewise these feasts next following shall be kept solemnly before and after noon and celebrated with solemnity, as: the Circumcision; the Three Kings or Epiphany; the Purification, the Annunciation and the Visitation of the Virgin Mary; John the Baptist; St Michael.

The St Mary's order at Danzig made the third day lesser, with two early sermons. In the margin a sixteenth-century hand wrote the contrary. **Danzig, draft *Feiertagsordnung* and St Mary's order of 1567** (Sehling 4, p. 187):

The third feast day shall be kept like the other two.

At Regensburg all three days are kept, but the third has neither communion nor the midday sermon. **Regensburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1567** (Sehling 13, p. 475):

On the feasts of Christ, each and every one, the Supper is held beside the sermons in the morning, and therefore also vespers on the evening before, for the communicants' sake. Yet at Christmas, Easter and Whitsuntide the Supper is held only the first two days, and on the third day, being the Tuesday, the midday sermon is left off in both churches, as followeth below.

In Prince Bernhard's Anhalt order the third day is graded by its music. **Anhalt, *Kirchenordnung* of Prince Bernhard, 1568** (Sehling 2, p. 569):

On high feasts one shall sing two holy days in figural music, and on the third day the Latin plain-song and the sequence *de tempore* (of the season).

The Wintzingerode order (§12.6.2) and Penig 1575 (§12.6.3) also make the third day lesser, with one sermon instead of two or three. Nassau-Weilburg 1609 (§12.6.2) makes it a half holy day.

12.7.2 Two days, and "two only"

Most Upper German orders keep the feast and the next day: "Easter Day together with the next day after it" (Württemberg 1553, §12.5.3). Two orders show the difference plainly.

The pastor of Goldlauter describes his practice in his report to the visitors. **Goldlauter (Henneberg), parish order, 1566** (Sehling 2, p. 333; printed "Groldlauter"):

So am I wont to keep it also on the high feasts, as standeth above, save only that the songs of each feast are sung instead of the former; and at Christmas we keep holy three days, at Easter and Whitsuntide but two, as standeth in the agenda.

Henneberg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1582 (§12.6.3) keeps "The first and second Christmas day. The first and second Easter day … First and second Whitsun day": two days at each feast, and so no third day at Christmas either.

12.7.3 St Stephen and St John in Christmas week

In the medieval calendar 26 and 27 December were the feasts of St Stephen and St John the Evangelist, both of high grade. Luther's *Formula missae* (Form of the Mass) keeps "the office of the Nativity" on those days (§12.3.1). The orders then choose among three answers:

- **They become the second and third days of Christmas**, with the Christmas Gospel and at most a mention of the saint. This is the common Lutheran solution.
- **They are kept as saints' days** within Christmas.
- **They are joined into one day**, as at Weißenburg 1528 (§12.5.7) and in one recension of Brenz's Hall order.

Schwäbisch Hall, Brenz, *Kirchenordnung*, 1527, variant B (Sehling 17/1, p. 53):

B: Christmas day together with St Stephen's day, so that St Stephen's and St John's, the day following, be kept for one holy day and not two

At Wolfenbüttel the saints are joined to the "festival sermon" of the second and third Christmas days as themes of their own. **Wolfenbüttel, *Kirchenordnung*, 1543** (Sehling 6/1, p. 62):

On St Stephen's day, beside the festival sermon, one shall also preach of the deacons or common chest-servants, and allege thereby the example of Stephen and Laurence, that a carefulness for the poor may be imprinted on the people. On the day of John the Evangelist one is to speak, beside the festival sermon, of the calling or vocation of every man.

Note.

- **Grubenhagen 1544** adds the Holy Innocents on 28 December as a fourth day of Christmas, kept "while the sermon lasteth" (§12.5.5).
- **Braunschweig 1528** tells the preacher to remember St John after the sermon of the third day of Christmas, and St Stephen after the sermon of the second (p. 398).

12.8 Individual feasts and where they stand

12.8.1 Purification and Annunciation: Marian names, feasts of Christ

Following Luther ("The feasts of the Purification and the Annunciation we hold as feasts of Christ", §12.3.1), almost every order keeps these two days and counts them among the feasts of Christ. The orders often rename them to make the point:

- "The day of the manifestation of Christ in the temple, which is called the Purification of Mary" (Saxony 1539, §12.5.2).
- "The day of the offering of Christ in the temple" (Mecklenburg 1552, §12.5.2).
- "The Annunciation of Mary or Conception of Christ".
- "The Purification of Christ and of Mary. The Annunciation of Christ" (Hausmann, Anhalt 1532, §12.5.7).

Their rank is still not fixed:

- **Whole holy days**: in Mecklenburg, Pfalz-Zweibrücken 1561, Mansfeld 1580 and Brieg 1592.
- **Half days**: in Landau 1562 and Ysenburg 1582 (§12.6.2).
- **Forenoon only**: in Württemberg 1536 (§12.5.3).

When the Annunciation falls in Holy Week it has to be moved, and the orders' rules for this show how its rank was understood (§12.14.2).

12.8.2 The Visitation

The Visitation (2 July) was a late-medieval feast, but its Gospel (Luke 1:39–56, with the *Magnificat*) made it acceptable. Homberg 1526 (Moderate Reformed) already keeps it (§12.3.2). Riga 1530 keeps it "because that was the first revelation of Christ, when he was yet in his mother's womb" (§12.3.7). Saxony 1539 keeps it "because of that history of the Gospel" (§12.5.2).

It usually stands in the second rank, beside John the Baptist and Michaelmas. In the Nürnberg family its date was moved to 15 August, to take the place of the Assumption and to spare the harvest (§12.6.4).

12.8.3 The Assumption: abolished, replaced, or kept "for the working peasants"

No feast shows the range of the orders better than the Assumption (15 August). It has no Gospel history. But in north Germany it was one of the four feasts on which the "four-times" offering was paid (§12.9), and elsewhere it was a harvest holiday. The orders deal with it in three ways.

1. Kept, but preached as the Visitation.

Brandenburg-Nürnberg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1533 (Sehling 11, p. 204):

Our Lady's day of her Ascension, not because it hath ground in holy Scripture, but for the sake of the common labouring country-folk. Yet on that feast the history of our Lady's feast called the Visitation, whereof there is witness in the holy Gospel, shall be kept in the churches with singing and reading

Tecklenburg has the same text in Low German, and there the day also counts as one of the four chief feasts. **Tecklenburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1543** (Sehling 22, p. 245):

Our dear Lady's Ascension day, called the Assumption, as a feast of the four high times; not that it hath ground in the holy Scripture, […] but for the sake of the common labouring work-folk; yet on that feast the history of the Visitation of Mary, whereof there is witness in the Gospel, shall be kept in the church with singing and reading.

Note. The Stift Osnabrück order of 1543 (Sehling 7/1, p. 223) forbids the feast outright. Its editor notes that some territories kept it as a *Vierzeitenfest* (four-times feast) on the Nürnberg model. Veit Dietrich's *Agendbüchlein* (agenda booklet) of 1545 moves the Visitation itself to 15 August (§12.6.4).

2. Abolished, and Michaelmas made the fourth chief feast in its place. This is the northern solution: Mecklenburg 1552 (§12.5.2), Hoya 1571 and Harlingerland 1573/74 (§12.5.5), Lippe 1571 and Oldenburg 1573 (§12.9). The Mecklenburg visitors of 1557 insisted on it.

Mecklenburg, *Visitations-Instruction*, 1557 (Sehling 5, p. 224):

It is also shewed how it shall be kept henceforth with one accord through the year with the feasts or holy days: namely that, beside the feasts of Christ, only the apostles' days shall be kept holy, as is set out at length in the church order; and in especial

that the feast of the Assumption of Mary shall henceforth be neither kept nor suffered, but that the day of Michael shall be a feast of the four times in its stead.

3. Simply kept. A number of orders keep the Assumption as a holy day:

- the conservative lists of Brandenburg 1540, Pfalz-Neuburg 1543, Hausmann 1532 and Weißenburg 1528 (§12.5.7);
- Nassau-Dillenburg 1537, among the harvest feasts moved to Sunday (§12.6.4);
- the Danish-Holstein order of 1542, "Feasts of the Ascension" (§12.5.4).

12.8.4 The other Marian feasts

The Conception (8 December), Nativity (8 September) and Presentation (21 November) of Mary have no Gospel history. Most orders drop them in silence. A few name them in order to abolish them, among them Sayn 1582, "But especially the feasts of the Conception, Nativity, Presentation and Assumption of Mary", and Regensburg 1567 (§12.3.7). A few keep one or more:

Order	Treatment
Anhalt, Hausmann, 1532 (§12.5.7)	"the Visitation and Conception of Mary", Assumption and Nativity all kept
Nassau-Dillenburg 1537 (Sehling 10, pp. 74–75)	Assumption and "the birth of Mary, called Nativitatis" kept
Brandenburg 1540 (§12.5.7)	Assumption and Nativity kept
Wied 1564 (Reformed; §12.4.5)	Nativity of Mary a sermon day ("only a sermon shall be held")
Anhalt 1568 (§12.4.5)	Visitation and Nativity of Mary kept *ferialiter* (in the ferial manner), with their Gospels, not as holy days
Teschen 1584 (§12.5.7)	"the birth of Mary" among the holy days

12.8.5 Michaelmas: the angels and the harvest

Michaelmas (29 September) rises highest of all the saints' days. Most orders give the day three themes, as Saxony 1539 does: "whereon to preach of the holy angels":

- the doctrine of the holy angels;
- thanksgiving for the harvest;
- in the north, the fourth payment of the four-times offering (§12.9).

Schleswig-Holstein, *Kirchenordnung*, 1542 (Sehling 23, p. 95):

The day of Michael is a common thanksgiving for all fruits which we have gathered and received in the year. Therefore the whole congregation shall straightway after the sermon sing for the thanksgiving, with great devotion, *Te Deum laudamus* (We praise thee, O God), etc. But the whole day through, as well in the morning as in the afternoon, one shall preach of the angels, that every man may understand what good we have received from God through their service, that we also may thank God therefor.

In Braunschweig the *Te Deum* (We praise thee, O God) is sung before the Gospel. **Braunschweig, *Kirchenordnung*, 1528** (Sehling 6/1, p. 397):

Then shall a preacher, when the epistle is read, before the Gospel, exhort the people to thank God for all benefits, and especially for the fruits of this year which he hath given us to gather in [...] he shall let *Te Deum* be sung, etc., before the Gospel is read.

Note. Michaelmas's rank still varies from place to place:

- **A chief feast**: the fourth *Vierzeitenfest* (four-times feast) in Braunschweig, Hamburg, Lübeck, Grubenhagen, Mecklenburg, Hoya, Lippe, Oldenburg and Waldeck.
- **Preached "before and after noon"**: in Mecklenburg, where it formally stands in the second rank.
- **A whole day with Te Deum**: in the Brunswick orders.
- **A half day**: in Pfalz-Zweibrücken 1561 (§12.6.2) and Nassau-Weilburg 1609.
- **A sermon day only**: in Wied 1564 (Reformed; §12.4.5).

- **A "small feast", though with three sermons**: in Danzig 1612 (§12.5.6).

12.8.6 John the Baptist

The Nativity of John the Baptist (24 June) is kept by nearly every order, usually in the second rank. The reason given is either the Gospel history of his birth or the office of preaching: "to the honour of the holy office of preaching the Gospel of Christ". The Pomeranian order of 1535 counts him with the feasts of Christ: "the feast belongeth also to Christ" (§12.5.4). The Wolfenbüttel order of 1543 gives his day a polemical theme.

Wolfenbüttel, *Kirchenordnung*, 1543 (Sehling 6/1, pp. 62–63):

On the day of John the Baptist one shall preach of the outward ministry of the divine Word against the Anabaptists, who [...] stand upon the saying, They shall be all taught of God; wherewith they would lay all the schools waste.

12.8.7 Trinity

The feast of the Trinity falls on a Sunday. It is usually listed at the end of the feasts of Christ with the note that it "falleth on the next Sunday after Whitsunday" (Saxony 1539, Mecklenburg 1552). Its rank is shown in four ways:

- **The Kyrie.** It shares the *Kyrie summum* with Pentecost at Nördlingen and Buxtehude (§12.4.2).
- **The Latin Mass.** It is one of the "high feasts of Christ" with a Latin Mass in Schleswig-Holstein 1542 (§12.10.1).
- **The Athanasian Creed.** It is read on the day and its vigil in the Thüngen lessons of 1587.
- **Solemnity.** It is kept "hochfeyerlich" in Verden 1606.

The Brandenburg-Ansbach chapter order of 1533 notes only that its office "is pure" (§12.4.4).

12.8.8 Mary Magdalene, the Conversion of Paul, the Beheading of John: kept for their Gospels

Three days that are not apostles' days are often ranked with them, because they have a story in the New Testament. These are the Conversion of Paul (25 January), Mary Magdalene (22 July, Luke 7:36–50) and the Beheading of John the Baptist (29 August). Where they are not holy days, the orders keep their Gospels on the nearest weekday or Sunday.

Mecklenburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1552 (Sehling 5, p. 201):

When such holy days fall as are not wont to be kept holy, and yet their histories are written in the Gospel, as is the day of the Conversion of Paul, Mary Magdalene, St John's beheading, etc., the preachers may read and handle the same text and histories in the sermon on such working day, namely Wednesday or Friday, as is next to such holy day.

Solms-Laubach gives a reason for keeping the Beheading of John. **Solms-Laubach, *Kirchenzuchtordnung*, 1603** (Sehling 9, p. 356):

The day of John's beheading may be laid on a common week-day sermon day (since the same hath a glorious history and witness how the world is wont to reward godly preachers), as also the Gospel of Mary Magdalene, since it containeth a profitable and comfortable history.

In Prussia Mary Magdalene's Gospel is given a fixed Sunday. **Prussia, *Kirchenordnung und Ceremonien*, 1568** (Sehling 4, p. 87):

The Gospel of Mary Magdalene, Luke 7, shall ordinarily and henceforth yearly be read and preached on the seventh Sunday after Trinity

12.8.9 Corpus Christi, the Holy Cross, local and new feasts

Corpus Christi. Most orders abolish it, and some order it to be explained so that people will know why it has gone.

Oldenburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1573 (Sehling 7/2.1, p. 1096):

The feast of Corpus Christi shall be done away according to God's Word, and the preachers shall on the Sunday before remind the people what great abuse and idolatry hath been practised therewith, which every Christian ought to shun according to the earnest commandment of God.

Two early orders keep it: Northeim for civic reasons, and Nassau-Dillenburg to teach the right use of the Sacrament.

Northeim, *Kirchenordnung*, 1539 (Sehling 6/2, p. 935):

The day of the Lord's true Body men have had to let stand for special political, that is, civil causes; yet so that the procession, with all other unchristian ceremonies, be done away, and only God's Word and the Lord's Supper be suffered to be handled and held thereon.

Nassau-Dillenburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1537 (Sehling 10, p. 74):

Our Lord's Body day, called Corpus Christi, shall be retained to this end, that one may rightly teach and preach thereon of the right use and fruit of the high holy Sacrament of the body and blood of Christ. But the Sacrament shall be neither set out nor carried about, on that nor on any other day in the year

The Holy Cross. Luther's "Let the feasts of the Holy Cross be anathema" (§12.3.1) is echoed in Sayn 1582, "the two days of the cross, the Finding and the Exaltation of the Cross" (§12.5.5). No order keeps them.

Local and civic feasts. Some towns kept days of their own, and the orders treat them in different ways:

- **Braunschweig.** St Autor had been honoured with a civic procession under a vow. It was turned into alms and a Sunday thanksgiving (Sehling 6/1, p. 398).
- **Wied 1564** (Reformed). Patronal feasts are kept with a sermon (§12.4.5).
- **New days.** Some towns added days of their own: a day of penance for the Osnabrück fire of 1613 (§12.6.2); a thanksgiving in Nördlingen for the town's deliverance from a planned surprise attack in 1440 (Sehling 12, pp. 387–388); and in Regensburg a dedication festival in October for the beginning of evangelical preaching in 1542 (Sehling 13, p. 475).

A new feast of Christ. Bugenhagen proposed a feast the medieval calendar did not have.

Braunschweig, *Kirchenordnung*, 1528 (Sehling 6/1, p. 380):

It is a wonder that there hath been no feast of the baptism of Christ, seeing there have been so many unprofitable feasts, to the destruction of body and soul. […] So that the Shrovetide Sunday may with us be called the feast of the baptism of Christ; one may then name it as one will.

Note. Wolfenbüttel 1543 keeps this "feast of the baptism" on the Sunday before Lent, with the Gospel of Matthew 3 preached "all day long" (Sehling 6/1, p. 62).

12.9 The *Vierzeiten*: the four chief feasts and the four offerings

In north and central Germany the highest rank of feasts had a name that came from church finance, not liturgy. These were the *vier Zeiten* (four times; Low German *veer tide* [the four times]), or the four *Hochzeiten* (high tides). They were the four feasts on which the "four-times penny" (*Vierzeitenpfennig*, *veertide pennink*) or offering was paid to the pastor or the church chest. Three of the four were fixed: Christmas, Easter and Whitsuntide. The fourth varied by region, as the editors' notes show. It was most often the Assumption (so at Minden, Sehling 21, p. 138). The Bergedorf order names St John the Baptist's day instead (Sehling 5, p. 389, cited by the Buxtehude editor, Sehling 7/1, p. 79). At St John's in Halberstadt the penny was collected quarterly, on John the Baptist's day, Michaelmas, and the Tuesdays of Christmas and Easter (Sehling 2, p. 488).

The Lutheran orders kept the payment, and with it the rank. Most of them replaced the Assumption with Michaelmas, which fell in the same season (after the harvest) and had a lawful Gospel theme (the angels). The *Vierzeiten* (the four times) are the Lutheran north's equivalent of the *summa festa* (highest feasts). A *Vierzeitenfest* (four-times feast) is a whole holy day, often with first vespers and a sermon on the eve, and with a Latin Mass.

12.9.1 The four times named

Bugenhagen's Lübeck order describes the treasure-chest. **Lübeck, *Kirchenordnung* (Bugenhagen), 1531** (Sehling 5, p. 362):

Into this chest shall come the four-times penny out of all the parishes. The four times are Easter, Whitsuntide, Michaelmas, Christmas. Then shall a great basin stand in all churches on the altar before the choir. Two churchwardens shall have an eye thereon and not be far from it; and all folk of twelve years and above, young and old, shall bring thither the times-penny.

A pre-Reformation police ordinance of Waldeck names the four *Hochzeiten* (high tides) first among the days on which attendance at Mass is enforced. **Waldeck, *Landordnung*, 1525** (Sehling 9, p. 179):

We also set, ordain and will, earnestly commanding, that every one of our subjects that is come to his years of discretion shall, on the four high-tide feasts and Sundays, and also on all our Lady's and apostles' days, hear in his parish church the office of the holy mass and the holy Gospel from their parson

The Pomeranian order sets out the due itself. **Pomerania, *Kerckenordeninge*, 1569** (Sehling 4, p. 414):

The four-times penny, every quarter, from every person above twelve years, a farthing, shall be given either to the pastor or to the church, as is the custom in every place.

The same dues are found in the lower Rhineland, in the Erasmian Catholic order of Jülich-Cleves, where they are called the "four high-tide offerings". **Jülich-Cleves-Berg, *Visitationsinstruktion*, 1559** (Roman Catholic humanist; Sehling 21, p. 87):

yet so that to every one the four high-tide offerings and loaves be given, as heretofore ordained

12.9.2 Michaelmas in the Assumption's place

The replacement was made by Braunschweig 1528 ("Item, Michaelmas for a four-times feast", §12.5.4) and Hamburg 1529. It became standard through Mecklenburg 1552 (§12.5.2) and the visitation of 1557 (§12.8.3). The later orders write it into their feast lists.

Lippe, *Kirchenordnung*, 1571 (Sehling 21, pp. 391–392):

The day of Michael, which in the stead of the feast of the Assumption of Mary is kept solemnly in our churches as a feast of the four times […] and whereon the needful comfortable doctrine of the dear holy angels is set forth and handled to the congregation of God. On these feasts it shall be done, as touching the order of the lessons, chants, sermons and communion, as on the common Sundays; only that the introits and sequences, and on the four-times feast days the prefaces *de tempore* (of the season), item the old German feast-songs, as above mentioned and customary with us, be sung.

Note. Lippe ranks the *Vierzeiten* (the four times) above the other feasts of Christ by one liturgical mark, the proper preface. The same order calls them "the glorious, fair, holy, chiefest four-times feasts" (p. 392).

Oldenburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1573 (Sehling 7/2.1, pp. 1096–1097):

The day of Michael, which is kept as a feast of the four times in the stead of the feast […] of the Assumption or Ascension of Mary, whereon the doctrine of the holy angels shall be set forth to the people. Likewise also on the same feast, after the epistle is read, a common thanksgiving shall be made for the fruits received, and the *Te Deum laudamus* (We praise thee, O God) be sung thereto.

In the Harlingerland order the payment is the reason given for Michaelmas taking the place. **Harlingerland, *Kirchenordnung*, 1573/74** (Sehling 7/1, p. 735):

We ordain therefore that the last and fourth high feast-tide shall be St Michael's day. And the parishioners shall on the same day render kindly to the pastor their offering, due duty and land-rent, and give and pay it without hindrance.

12.9.3 The *Vierzeiten* as a liturgical rank

At Wolfenbüttel a sermon at first vespers is allowed only on the four. The same words stand in Hildesheim 1544 (Sehling 7/2.1, p. 858). **Wolfenbüttel, *Kirchenordnung*, 1543** (Sehling 6/1, p. 62):

On the greatest feasts, or four times, Christmas, Easter, Whitsuntide and Michaelmas, one may preach for an hour at the first vespers. On the other feasts it is not needful.

Hoya has the Mass in Latin throughout. **Hoya, *Kirchenordnung*, 1571** (Sehling 6/2, p. 1151):

VI. Of the four-times feasts. On the four-times feasts one shall hold the office of the mass in our churches, where it can be had, throughout in Latin, with the introit, Kyrie eleison, *Gloria in excelsis*, collects, epistles, sequences, Gospels, etc.; yet so that the wonted German psalms which are appointed for the feasts (that the church also may sing) be not forgotten.

In Lauenburg the *hohe Vierzeitenfeste* (high four-times feasts) are the days for the alms collection, and the meal the pastor used to give the churchwardens on those days is abolished. **Lauenburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1585** (Sehling 5, p. 421):

Fourteenthly, they shall on all Sundays, and on the holy days and the high four-times feasts, diligently gather the collection from the people during the sermon, write it down and lay it by [...] And lastly there shall be wholly done away on the high four-times feasts the collation and feasting which the pastor hath hitherto had to give the churchwardens on such feasts.

In the Neumark the churchwardens are to take the collection plate round on the high feasts generally, not only on the four. **Neumark (Brandenburg), instruction of Margrave Johann for the visitors, 1540** (Sehling 3, p. 36):

The same churchwardens shall also go about in the church with the plate on all high holy feasts, not only on the four times

Note. Grubenhagen 1544 defines its first rank of feasts by this payment ("the four chief feasts, on which the four-times penny is gathered", §12.5.5). Henneberg 1582 has four chief feasts, but they are Christmas, Easter, Ascension and Whitsuntide (§12.6.3). It shows that "four chief feasts" could be understood liturgically as well as fiscally.

12.10 Keeping the feast in church: ceremonial marks, abolished ceremonies and the seasons

Beyond whole and half holy days, the orders mark the higher feasts with a set of ceremonial additions. None of them is new. Each carries on, in reduced form, a feature of the medieval feast grades. Listed from the commonest to the rarest:

Mark	Higher feasts	Lower feasts and ordinary days	Examples
Sermons	two or three, sometimes four; a sermon at first vespers	one sermon, in the forenoon	§12.6.3; Wolfenbüttel 1543 (§12.9.3); Danzig (§12.5.6)
Latin chant	introit, *Gloria*, Alleluia, sequence, *Patrem* (the Nicene Creed), preface, Sanctus, *Agnus Dei* (Lamb of God) in Latin	German hymns	§12.10.1
Kyrie grade	*summum* (the highest [chant]), *paschale* (Easter [Kyrie]), *festivale*	*dominicale* (Sunday [Kyrie]), *angelicum* (angelic [Kyrie]), *apostolicum* (apostles' [Kyrie]), *feriale*	§12.4.2, §12.10.2
Proper preface	preface of the feast (*de tempore*, *solemnis*)	common preface, exhortation, or none	§12.10.3
Sequence	kept on the great feasts	dropped	§12.10.4
Figural music and organ	figural music, organ	plain-song or German; no organ	§12.10.5
Vestments, elevation	mass vestment, elevation	choir robe or none	§12.10.6
Bells	more bells, chiming (*beiern*) the day before	one bell	§12.10.7
Creed and *Te Deum* (We praise thee, O God)	*Athanasianum* (Athanasian Creed), Latin *Te Deum*	—	§12.10.8
Communion	communion and first vespers with confession	no communion on apostles' days	§12.10.9
Civil marks	no weddings, markets or guild feasts	—	§12.11.3

12.10.1 Latin chant on the high feasts

The Saxon *Unterricht der Visitatoren* (Instruction of the Visitors) of 1528 set the pattern. Latin is kept for the higher feasts "because it is unseemly always to sing one song".

Saxony (Ernestine), *Unterricht der Visitatoren*, 1528 (Sehling 1, pp. 165 and 169):

On high feasts, as Christmas, Easter, the Ascension, Whitsuntide, or the like, it were good that certain Latin chants, agreeable to Scripture, were used at the mass. For it is an unseemly thing evermore to sing one song. […] With the feasts also it shall be done peaceably: that where certain plain holy days have fallen away, men make not much strife thereof. And forasmuch as it is also unseemly that the chants be all alike on all feasts, it were good that on the most glorious feasts there were sung the Latin introits, *Gloria in excelsis Deo* (Glory to God in the highest), Alleluia, the pure sequences, Sanctus, *Agnus Dei* (Lamb of God).

In Ernestine Saxony the rule depends on the place as well as the day. **Saxony (Ernestine), *Gemeine Verordnung*, 1533** (Sehling 1, p. 192):

In towns and market towns, where there are boys' schools and folk that understand Latin, one may hold mass in Latin on high feasts, otherwise in German; but in the villages, where no man understandeth Latin, one shall hold mass in German throughout […] Note: even when mass is held in Latin on high feasts, yet the epistle, the Gospel, the words of the Sacrament and the Lord's Prayer are all read in German and aloud

In Schleswig-Holstein the high feasts are named, and Trinity is one of them. **Schleswig-Holstein, *Kirchenordnung*, 1542** (Sehling 23, p. 91):

On the high feasts of Christ, which are Christmas, Easter, Whitsuntide and Trinity, one shall sing in the towns in Latin the introits, *Gloria in excelsis*, Alleluia with pure sequences; item Latin prefaces, which the priest beginneth thus: *Dominus vobiscum* (The Lord be with you), etc., *Sursum corda* (Lift up your hearts), etc.; thereafter the Sanctus; lastly the *Pater noster* with the words of the Supper, yet these always in the German tongue

At Buxtehude the *Gloria* follows the rank. **Buxtehude, *Kirchenordnung*, 1552** (Sehling 7/1, p. 74):

Next shall be sung the Kyrie eleison as occasion serveth, *Gloria in excelsis* and the *Et in terra* (And on earth): on the high feasts always in Latin, on the Sundays and otherwise in German or in Latin, as the time will allow.

Thorn has the reverse rule. On Sundays the chants before the sermon are in Latin, but the small feasts are wholly German. **Thorn, *Kirchenordnung*, 1575** (Sehling 4, p. 238):

Otherwise the chants, collects and lessons before the sermon are all held in Latin. On the apostles' days and other small feasts, which are wont to be kept with half solemnity, the whole office is held in German, both in the Old and the New Town

12.10.2 Chant on the apostles' days

The lower feasts have their own marks in several orders. They are enough to set them off from working days without matching Sundays.

The Pomeranian *Agenda* gives the rule for the apostles' days. **Pomerania, *Agenda*, 1569** (Sehling 4, p. 469):

These following apostles' days one shall keep holy before noon. On the Sunday before, the preachers shall bid them and exhort every man to come to church on these days. On the evening before one shall ring or chime *festivaliter*, and hold vespers; in the morning likewise ring *festivaliter*, preach at seven or eight, yet deal out no testament [no communion]; but one may hold the office before the altar before the sermon, read the *Gloria*, collect, epistle and Gospel with the tone, that there may be a difference between these days and the common working days. When church is out, every man goeth to his work.

The Aschersleben agenda sets out the apostles' day Mass and vespers. **Aschersleben, *Kirchen-Agenda*, 1575** (Sehling 2, p. 480):

Of vespers on the apostle's eve. Vespers shall be held as on the Saturday, yet so that one sing *de festo* (of the feast) and read the collects *de festo* also. Of the mass on the apostles' days. 1. After the ringing, which shall be done as on a working day, the cantor straightway beginneth the introit. 2. Thereupon followeth the *Kyrie apostolicum* (apostles' Kyrie). 3. Then is sung the German "Allein Gott in der Höh" (To God alone on high be glory), etc. 4. The collect of the feast of the apostle, and thereafter the epistle

is read. […] Of vespers on the apostles' days. Vespers are sung without the organist, as otherwise on a working day, since no sermon is held.

The Riga order gives the melody of the Kyrie. **Riga, *Kirchenordnung*, 1530** (Sehling 5, p. 15):

After the introit one singeth the Kyrie eleison with few notes (save on the high feasts, when one may take the paschal note)

12.10.3 Proper prefaces

Proper prefaces belonged only to the great feasts, and the orders use them to mark those days.

The same text is in Hamburg 1529 (Sehling 5, p. 528). **Braunschweig, *Kirchenordnung*, 1528** (Sehling 6/1, p. 441):

Thereafter he turneth him to the altar, and on the great feasts which have special prefaces, and else, when he will, on certain Sundays with the preface of the Trinity (which was made against the Arians, as was the Nicene Creed also), he shall begin in Latin the preface *Dominus vobiscum* (The Lord be with you) and sing it to the end; whereupon let the choir sing a Latin Sanctus.

In Ottheinrich's order the preface itself has two grades. **Pfalz-Neuburg, *Kirchenordnung* of Ottheinrich, second printing 1547** (Sehling 14, p. 109):

But for certain high feasts, the feast of Easter, the Ascension, Whitsuntide, Trinity, etc., there are special prefaces, two for each feast, a *solemnis* and a *dominicalis*; these a priest may note out or write out, and have always on the desk beside the church order

Note. The *solemnis* and *dominicalis* tones of the preface are the melodic grades of the medieval preface: the festal tone for the feast itself, the ferial or Sunday tone for the days within its season. The order prints the Trinity preface as its example.

At Hatzkerode there is an exhortation on ordinary days and the preface on the great feasts. **Hatzkerode (Harzgerode, Anhalt), *Kirchenordnunge*, 1534(?)** (Sehling 2, p. 587):

Then shall the priest turn him about and read unto them the exhortation, as it standeth in the agenda. But on the great feasts, in the stead thereof, the preface of the feast shall be sung, with the wonted Sanctus in Latin.

Thorn, *Kirchenordnung*, 1575 (Sehling 4, p. 237):

After the sermon followeth a German hymn; thereupon the priests on high feasts sing the preface *de tempore* (of the season) to the wonted notes; but on the common Sundays and holy days [the priest], without the same, turneth to the people straightway after the German hymn

Kurland allows German proper prefaces for the high feasts, "for variety". **Kurland, *Kirchenordnung*, 1570** (Sehling 5, p. 89):

But where one will sing on the high feasts, for a change (as is done at the prince's court), these prefaces hereafter set down and noted, instead of the daily one, it shall be free to every minister

Note. Saxony 1539 prints Latin prefaces for Christmas, Epiphany, Easter, Ascension, Pentecost and Trinity, and a *Praefatio quotidiana* (daily Preface) for all other days (Sehling 1, p. 274, editor's summary). The Mecklenburg family allows "prefaces of the season" on the feasts of Christ (§12.5.2). Lippe 1571 restricts them to the *Vierzeiten* (the four times; §12.9.2).

12.10.4 Sequences

In Schleswig-Holstein sequences are dropped except on the three great feasts, and each great feast keeps its own sequence. **Schleswig-Holstein, *Kirchenordnung*, 1542** (Sehling 23, p. 90):

The sequences and proses shall all be left off and not be sung, save on the three great feasts of Christ: as from Christmas unto Candlemas, *Grates nunc omnes* (Let us all now give thanks), with its German song; from Easter unto Whitsuntide, *Victimae paschali*, with its German song; then in Whitsuntide, *Veni, Sancte Spiritus*, with its German song.

Note.

- **Seasons, not days.** The sequence is kept through the whole season of each great feast, from Christmas to Candlemas and from Easter to Whitsuntide.

- **Aschersleben 1575.** The cantor "the Sundays after these feasts sing the sequences in the church".
- **The Mecklenburg family.** Sequences are "de tempore" (of the season) on the feasts of Christ (§12.5.2).

12.10.5 Figural music and the organ

Hamburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1556 (Sehling 5, p. 551):

Also the figural song shall on the chiefest feasts be orderly observed and sung in one parish as well as in the others.

The Hof order gives the title of its collection of polyphonic music in the table of contents; the collection itself begins on p. 456. **Hof, *Ordo ecclesiasticus*, 1592** (Sehling 11, p. 477):

XVI. An order of the sweetest and best songs, chosen out of the most excellent masters both old and new, which are sung in figural music under the leading of the cantor, directed to the chief feasts of the whole year

In the Pomeranian *Agenda* there is no figural music or organ in Rogation week, except on the Ascension and its vigil. **Pomerania, *Agenda*, 1569** (Sehling 4, p. 466):

On this Sunday and in the week one shall sing no figural song, nor play the organ, save the day of the Ascension of the Lord, with its vigil

Other examples:

- **Anhalt 1568**: figural music on the first two days of the high feasts, Latin chorale on the third (§12.7.1).
- **Regensburg 1567**: figural music at the vespers before, and the communion on, the feasts of Christ (p. 475).
- **Henneberg 1582**: lower feasts are kept "one orgeln" (§12.6.3).
- **Schwarzburg 1587**: the organ is used on the apostles' days in the forenoon (Sehling 2, p. 137).
- **Aschersleben 1575**: the vespers of apostles' days are sung "without the organist" (§12.10.2).

The seasons and rites in which the organ was silent are treated in Chapter 9, §9.3.6.

12.10.6 Vestments and elevation

In Prince Bernhard's Anhalt order the elevation of the Sacrament is kept only on the high feasts. **Anhalt, *Kirchenordnung* of Prince Bernhard, 1568** (Sehling 2, p. 570):

Forasmuch as the elevation of the most worthy Sacrament of the true body and blood of Christ hath fallen away in one church but not in another, the ministers shall elevate on high feasts; beyond these the said Prince Bernhard is content that it be left off. Likewise on Sunday the choir robe shall be used at all three sermons, and through the week it may be left off.

Note.

- **Grimma 1529.** The mass vestment is required on the three-day high feasts (§12.7.1).
- **Querfurt.** According to Sehling's account of the visitation, mass vestments were worn at communion and, for a time, in the pulpit on the three chief feasts (Sehling 2, p. 460).

12.10.7 Bells

Altenburg, castle chapter, *Verordnung der ceremonien*, 1533 (Sehling 1, p. 516):

Thirdly, one shall also henceforth keep this difference: that on common working days one ring to the holy office of the sermon with one great bell, and on Sundays and other feasts with more bells, to distinguish the time.

The fullest bell-code is the Danzig one of 1612 (§12.5.6). It names five bells:

- Osanna;
- Apostolica;
- Dominical;
- Ferial;
- Sybilla.

The great feasts are rung in with the great bell and the three larger bells chimed together (*beiern*). The small feasts are chimed "with the Osanna".

The bells in general, their signs and their uses, are treated in Chapter 9, §9.5.

12.10.8 The Athanasian Creed and the *Te Deum*

The Mecklenburg convent order gives the rule for the convents' matins. **Mecklenburg, *Klosterordnung*, 1572** (Sehling 5, p. 258):

On the high feasts, as Christmas, Epiphany, Easter, Ascension, Whitsuntide and Trinity, the Athanasian Creed shall be sung in German straightway after the Benedictus.

For the *Te Deum* (We praise thee, O God) in Latin "on the greater feasts" see Transylvania 1547 (§12.4.3). For the *Te Deum* as the Michaelmas thanksgiving see §12.8.5.

12.10.9 Communion and confession

The orders do not give the Supper by rank as such. Communion is held whenever there are communicants. But rank shows in the preparation and in the days on which communion is normally held.

- **Regensburg 1567.** Communion and vespers on the eve go with every feast of Christ, but not with the third day of the great feasts (§12.7.1).
- **Pomerania 1569.** No communion on apostles' days (§12.10.2).
- **Stade, *Kirchenordnung*, c. 1620/22** (Sehling 7/1, p. 54). On the three high feasts confession is heard after the afternoon sermon of the first day, and the Supper is given on the second day, "which is not done on the first and the last feast day".
- **First vespers.** The vespers of the eve of the higher feasts were also the time for private confession of the next day's communicants (for example Leiningen 1584, p. 278: "on the high feast days a vespers the evening before").

12.10.10 Festal ceremonies abolished

The plays and processions of the year. The late-medieval feasts had their own acted ceremonies:

- the Palm Sunday ass;
- the crucifix laid in the "grave" on Good Friday;
- the image of the risen Christ carried round on Easter Day;
- the figure of Christ drawn up through the church roof on Ascension Day;
- the dove let down on Whitsunday;
- the rocking of the Christ-child's cradle at Christmas;
- processions round the church with holy water, crosses and the sacrament.

The south German orders abolish them by name. They also abolish the blessings of the year: water and salt on Sundays, candles at Candlemas, ashes on Ash Wednesday, palms on Palm Sunday, and the Easter candle, font and fire on Holy Saturday. **Hohenlohe, *Kirchenordnung*, 1553** (Sehling 15, p. 77):

In like manner shall also be left off all spectacles and shows which have been practised with images: as on Palm Sunday with the ass, on Good Friday with the crucifix and the grave, on Easter Day with the carrying about of the image of the resurrection of Christ, on Ascension Day with the drawing up of the same, on Whitsunday with the letting down of the dove, on Christmas Day with the rocking of the little child, and whatever more of the like hath been in use. Item, all processions and goings about the church with holy water and crosses, and also with the carrying about of the holy sacrament in the monstrance, etc.

The same list stands in Pfalz-Neuburg 1543 (Sehling 13, pp. 95–96) and the Palatine *Bedenken zur Reformation der Stiftskirchen* (Opinion on the reformation of the collegiate churches) of 1546 (Sehling 14, p. 93). The Corpus Christi procession went with the feast itself (§12.8.9).

What stayed. What the orders keep for the feasts is the reading and preaching of the feast's history, its hymns and sequences, its proper preface, and in many places its Latin chant (§12.10.1–12.10.4). The *Leisen* sung from the pulpit at the high feasts are treated in Chapter 8 §8.10.2.

12.10.11 Seasonal changes in the service

Advent and Lent. Some orders mark the penitential seasons by plainer chant and by leaving out the *Gloria*. The Pomeranian order of 1542 gives the old Kyrie grades by season: *dominicale* (Sunday [Kyrie]) in Advent and Lent, *paschale* (Easter [Kyrie]) from Easter to Whitsun, *summum* (the highest [chant]) on the higher feasts. In Lent the *Gloria* may be left out altogether. **Pomerania, *Kirchenordnung*, 1542** (Sehling 4, p. 356):

Thereupon the Kyrie *dominicale*; or one may also on the Sundays sing the Kyrie *angelicum* (angelic [Kyrie]), *de martyribus* (of martyrs), or *confessoribus*, or *virginibus*, as they have been named; the *dominicale* in Advent and in Lent, the *paschale* between Pentecost and Easter, the *summum* on the higher feasts, or the *minus summum* (the lesser summum). Thereupon the priest singeth the *Gloria in excelsis* [...] in Lent one may well leave out the *Gloria* altogether, or when it will be too long.

Other seasonal changes in the orders:

- **The Creed in Advent.** At Schweinfurt "Wir glauben all" (We all believe) replaces "Nun bitten wir" (Now pray we) on the three Sundays of Advent (Sehling 11, p. 646).
- **The Litany.** Days kept "plainly, *dominicaliter*, as in Advent and Lent" may have the Latin Litany (Pomerania, *Karcken ordening* [church order], Sehling 4, p. 354).
- **Hymns.** The hymn tables change with the seasons: Advent, Christmas to Candlemas, Easter to Whitsun (see Chapter 8 §8.7.5 for the *Gloria* in Advent and Lent, and §8.10.3 for the seasonal hymns before the sermon).
- **Luther's warning.** Luther himself would not have Lent, Holy Week or Good Friday shown off "with other rites" than the rest of the year (§12.12.1).

12.11 Keeping holy days in common life

The orders kept the calendar by law as much as by liturgy. A holy day was a day on which work, trade and amusement were restricted, and the restrictions were enforced by the magistrate. This section covers the rest from work (§12.11.1), its enforcement (§12.11.2), weddings, guild feasts and markets (§12.11.3), the folk festivals of the year (§12.11.4), and one feast created to replace them (§12.11.5). Harvest exemptions are treated in §12.6.4.

12.11.1 Rest: the whole day, the forenoon, or the time of the sermon

Not a commandment, but good order. The first Saxon visitors already gave the principle. The ceremonies of the church, the holy days among them, are not commanded by God. They are kept "for the sake of good order and peace", as each parish has the custom. **Ernestine Saxony, *Unterricht der visitatoren an die pfarrherrn*, 1528** (Sehling 1, p. 164):

For such things are more needful than to eat flesh on Friday and the like, although that is right before God and in the conscience. Yet the people shall nevertheless be taught to speak modestly of such church orders; for some church orders are made for the sake of good order and peace, as St Paul saith in the first to the Corinthians, the fourteenth: Let all things be done in order in the church. Therefore the holy days, as Sunday and some more, shall be kept, as is the custom of each parish.

Degrees of rest. In practice the orders set three degrees:

- **Sunday and the high feasts**: no work all day;
- **the half holy days**: no work until noon, or until the sermon was over (§12.6.1);
- **the other holy days**: no work during the service only.

A visitation recess for an Oldenburg parish states the difference between Sunday and the other holy days in one sentence. It lists the work forbidden: carting turf, hay and sheaves, ploughing, harrowing, mowing and digging. The penalty is that the offender's horses are unharnessed until he pays. **Oldenburg, *Visitationsabschied für Bardenfleth*, 1609** (Sehling 7/2.1, p. 1201):

that on Sundays wholly, but on the other holy days during the sermon, there be refraining from carting turf, hay [and] sheaves, from ploughing, harrowing, mowing, [and] digging, and in other ways from handiwork; also that during divine service no one tap beer or wine; and that the wilful transgressors be punished as is due by unharnessing of the horses until [the fine be] paid [...]

Work allowed after the sermon. Pfalz-Zweibrücken allowed field work on all holy days except Sunday and the three high feasts, "especially in harvest and autumn", on condition that the people had first heard the sermon. The reason given was that

"some holy days hinder working people in their living", while giving the idle occasion "to feast, carouse and drink wine". **Pfalz-Zweibrücken, *Generalartikel*, 1560** (Sehling 18, p. 293):

And whereas the subjects in the country have also brought forward complaint hereupon, that some holy days hinder working folk in their living, but give to others, who without that seek occasion for idleness, opportunity to gorge, carouse and drink wine, we are content that, apart from the three high feasts and the holy Sunday, on the other holy days, especially in harvest and autumn time, our subjects may attend to their necessary field and other work; yet so that on that same day they have first attended God's word and the sermon.

"Loose holy days". Where the lesser feasts had been kept by halves, the people treated them as working days altogether. A Henneberg pastor complained that on the days "which the common man is wont to call loose holy days" the villagers did their road-mending and timber-carting, and went hunting after the early sermon. **Wasungen, *Kirchen-Ordnung*, 1566** (Sehling 2, pp. 356–357):

for because in other places these holy days have been in part abolished, and the cry hath gone forth that they shall soon fall altogether, men have undertaken on such holy days, which the common man is wont to call loose holy days, all manner of common and private work, as making the common ways, going to the land-defences, carting building timber and more of the like […]. Early a sermon is done; thereafter one hunteth, or every man worketh what he will.

12.11.2 Enforcement: gates, fines and taverns

The town gates shut. The Brandenburg visitors told town councils to shut the gates on holy-day mornings, so that no one could go out to work in the fields. **Cölln on the Spree, *Visitations-Abschied*, 1540** (Sehling 3, p. 194):

It hath come credibly before the visitors that there are many disobedient people who profane the holy day with carting and working, and otherwise also; therefore the honourable council shall keep the gates shut on the holy day before noon, [and] suffer no one [to go] out of them to work

The same order recurs in the visitation recesses for Salzwedel 1579 and Stendal 1578 (Sehling 3, pp. 285, 300, 331).

Fines. The town mandates fix the fine. Strasbourg (1534, Moderate Reformed) forbade every kind of handiwork on Sunday: stacking wood, unloading wood or sand, bucking and washing. The fine was thirty shillings. Milk and bread might be sold, and in Lent fish, until the last bell for the sermon. **Strasbourg, *Mandat zur Sonntagsheiligung*, 1534** (Moderate Reformed; Sehling 20/1, p. 246):

First, since Sunday is ordained for the hearing of God's word, that no one in the city of Strasbourg or its precincts shall on Sunday, without special weighty [and] honest cause or pressing need, do any handiwork whatsoever, be it with stacking wood, unloading wood or sand, bucking or washing, or other works, whatever they be, on pain of thirty shillings pfennig.

The discipline orders of the Wetterau counts set fines for each offence: for walking in the fields during the sermon, for trading, for sitting in the wine-house or working in the field (Hanau-Münzenberg, *Reformationsmandat für das Amt Rodheim*, 1596, Reformed, Sehling 10, p. 414; see Chapter 11 §11.12 for the fines for absence and for disturbing the sermon). Taverns were to stay shut during divine service on Sundays and holy days alike.

12.11.3 Weddings, guild feasts and markets

Wedding feasts, guild banquets and markets were moved away from the high feasts, so that they would not draw people from the sermon. The closed seasons for weddings in Advent and Lent are treated in §12.12.6.

Mansfeld, *Kirchen-agenda*, 1580 (Sehling 2, p. 240):

Of weddings at the chief feasts. Forasmuch as it is very unmeet that wedding-feasts be held at the chief feasts, the same shall henceforth be wholly stayed at such feasts: and at Christmas, eight days before, and until the Sunday after the Three Kings; likewise at Easter until the Sunday Quasimodogeniti; and at Whitsuntide until the Sunday Trinity, no wedding shall be allowed

Hadersleben, *Zuchtordnung*, 1573 (Sehling 23, p. 244):

The guild-feasts also shall no more be held on the high feasts, and especially on Whitsunday, but be put off to another day.

Brandenburg, *Visitation- und Consistorialordnung*, 1573 (Sehling 3, p. 129):

The magistrates also shall ordain that the weekly markets which fall on high feasts be put off until after noon, or to the next day following, that God's Word be not hindered thereby.

12.11.4 Fastnacht, Kirchweih, May Day and Midsummer

"Heathen" festivals. The folk festivals of the year were attacked as "heathen" in mandate after mandate:

- Shrovetide (*Fastnacht*) with its masks, dances and begging for eggs and meat;
- the church-dedication fair (*Kirchweih*, *Kirmes*);
- May Day and Walpurgis night, with the May-tree;
- Whitsun ales, the *Pfingstbier*;
- the Midsummer fires of St John's Eve;
- the *Hagelfeier*, a day of processions against hail.

The Hessian *Reformationsordnung* of 1572 (Philippist) forbids "Sunday dances, especially during the sermon and the catechism", and all such "frivolous wantonness". **Hesse, *Reformationsordnung*, 1572** (Philippist; Sehling 8, p. 401):

So also shall the Sunday dances, especially during the sermon and the catechism, and also all other frivolous wantonness which is practised and undertaken by the common man after heathen manner at Shrovetide, Walpurgis, Whitsuntide, St John's day and at other times more through the year, be wholly forbidden; and the transgressors shall each time be earnestly punished by our officers according to the form of the wantonness practised, and the fine brought in to us. But when there are weddings, one may dance modestly

The same list recurs in Nassau-Weilburg 1576 (with the "*Hagel* holy days" and the Walpurgis and St John's fires, Sehling 10, p. 310), Solms 1603 (Sehling 9, p. 351) and Ysenburg (Sehling 10, p. 707). Separate *Fastnacht* mandates were issued in Waldeck (1547, 1563, 1589/90), Ysenburg (1590, 1612, Reformed) and Baden (1610) (Sehling 9, pp. 222, 297, 301; 10, pp. 593, 693; 16, p. 572). Kurpfalz banned church-dedication fairs, Shrovetide and mummery outright in its police legislation (Sehling's introduction, Sehling 14, p. 66), and Waldeck abolished the *Kirchweih* in 1583 (Sehling 9, p. 299). The Franconian order of Thüngen named Corpus Christi and the *Hagelfeier* together as feasts "whereby God is blasphemed" (Sehling 11, p. 737).

12.11.5 Shrove Sunday turned into a feast of baptism

A new feast in place of an old one. Bugenhagen's Hamburg order turned the Sunday before Lent, the beginning of Shrovetide, into a day for preaching on baptism. The Gospel was the baptism of Christ (Matthew 3). He remarks that there had never been a feast of Christ's baptism, though there had been "so many useless feasts". **Hamburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1529** (Sehling 5, p. 507):

Therefore it is thought good to use the Shrove Sunday especially for preaching of baptism. In the morning there shall be preached in all the parish churches the Gospel of Matthew 3, how Christ was baptized in the Jordan by St John. That is a comfortable and gracious history of the Lord Christ, which surely shall not be kept silent. It is a wonder that there hath not been a feast of the baptism of Christ, whereas there have been so many unprofitable feasts, to the ruin of body and soul.

The Schleswig-Holstein order of 1542 has the same rule (Sehling 23, p. 94). The Pomeranian *Agenda* of 1569 explains its purpose: the people are to be reminded of their baptism, "that by God's Spirit they may be the more led away from the heathenish, unchristian Shrovetide doings" (Sehling 4, p. 473).

12.12 The seasons of the year

The evangelical orders kept the shape of the church year: Advent, Christmas, Lent, Holy Week, Easter, Ascension, Whitsun and the Trinity season. What they changed was what each season meant in practice. Lent lost its fast (§12.13) but kept its preaching. The seasons with the most extra services were Lent and Holy Week. Their additions were sermons and catechism, not Masses. This section covers Luther's starting point (§12.12.1), Advent (§12.12.2), Lent (§12.12.3), Holy Week (§12.12.4), Rogation week and the catechism seasons (§12.12.5), the closed seasons for weddings (§12.12.6) and the Ember days (§12.12.7).

12.12.1 Luther: no special show for Lent

The *Formula missae*. Luther would not mark Lent, Holy Week or Good Friday with rites that set them apart from the rest of the year. To do so, with the half-Mass of the Presanctified and the denial of the cup, would be "to mock and laugh at Christ". **Luther, *Formula missae et communionis*, 1523** (Sehling 1, p. 5):

Further, the Lenten graduals and the like, which exceed two verses, let whosoever will sing at home. In the church we will not have the spirit of the faithful quenched with tedium. Neither is it meet to display Lent itself, or the Greater Week, or the Friday of the Passion, with other rites than any other [days], lest we seem to wish to mock and laugh at Christ any longer with a half-Mass and with one part of the sacrament. For the Alleluia is the perpetual voice of the church, even as the memory of his passion and victory is perpetual.

In 1526 he said the same of Holy Week, which "shall be even as other weeks", with the Passion preached an hour a day (*Deutsche Messe*, Sehling 1, p. 16; see Chapter 11 §11.4.4). The later orders did not all follow him in the chant. Some left the *Gloria* out in Lent and used the plain Kyrie (§12.10.11).

12.12.2 Advent

The coming of Christ. Advent is kept as a season of preaching on the prophecies of Christ's coming and on the Last Day. The Pomeranian *Agenda* gives weekday sermons for it. **Pomerania, *Agenda*, 1569** (Sehling 4, p. 463):

But how one shall preach in Advent on the working days, the prophecies of the coming of Christ and the Lord Christ's sermons of the Last Day, that followeth hereafter.

Advent was also a season for the catechism. At Allstedt (1533) the pastor was to examine the children "three times in the year, in Advent, in Lent and after the harvest" (Sehling 1, p. 511). The Niederwildungen catechism order of 1533 (Waldeck) held the catechism three days a week in Advent (Sehling 9, p. 191).

12.12.3 Lent: repentance, the Passion and the catechism

Preaching. Lent kept its old name, *die Fasten* (Lent) or *Quadragesima* (Lent), but its content became preaching. The Württemberg order sets the themes: repentance through Lent; on Palm Sunday the whole Passion read to the young people in three parts; on Maundy Thursday and Good Friday the Passion expounded. **Württemberg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1553** (Sehling 16, p. 267):

In Lent, called *Quadragesima*, there shall be preaching of right Christian repentance. On Palm Sunday it is profitable, beside the history of Palm Sunday, to read to the young people the history of the whole Passion, divided into three times, namely morning, afternoon and at Vesper time; and thereafter to expound the same history to the common church on Maundy Thursday and Good Friday, and to explain its profit and use with special earnestness and diligence.

The same text stands in Pfalz-Neuburg 1554, Pfalz-Zweibrücken 1557, Pfalz-Veldenz 1574 and Kurpfalz 1556 (Sehling 18, pp. 207, 520; 14, p. 163). The division of the Passion into a series of Lenten sermons is described in Chapter 11 §11.4.4.

More weekday sermons. In Lent the weekday sermons were increased. In the Corvey village of Bruchhausen there was a sermon one day a week through Lent and two in the week before Easter. **Corvey, *Kirchenordnung für das Corveyer Stiftsdorf Bruchhausen*, 1603** (Sehling 21, p. 243):

Over and above these holy days and prayer days now named, there shall also in Lent be preaching weekly one day in the week, but before Easter two days, the Thursday and Friday, and the history of the Passion of Christ be set before the people.

Daily catechism instead of the *Salve Regina*. The commonest daily service of Lent was the catechism, held at the hour when the *Salve Regina* had once been sung. **Gotha, *Artikel durch die hern visitatores einem erbarn rathe zu Gotha zugestellet*, 1555** (Sehling 1, p. 569):

Every day in Lent, beginning straightway on the first Sunday, [at the hour] when in the papacy the idolatrous *Salve Regina* was sung, the catechism is held with the children every day until Palm Sunday. A psalm is sung, as the 8th, 16th, 22nd, 69th, 110th etc., which remember the Passion of Christ, beside the part of the catechism which is to be handled; thereafter a lesson is read out of Sirach, the Proverbs of Solomon, or whatever other lesson is appointed by the pastor

Calenberg 1542 gives the same rule (Sehling 6/2, p. 804). The Upper Lusatian orders of Zittau and Herwigsdorf had the catechism preached every weekday in Lent "at Salve time" (Sehling 3, p. 379).

The Easter communion and the examination. Lent ended in the Easter communion, which drew the young people "in great number" (Regensburg 1572, Sehling 13, p. 509). The catechism was therefore examined on the Sundays of Lent. **Albertine Saxony, *Ordnung* of Duke August, 1580** (Sehling 1, p. 424):

Secondly, the pastor shall proclaim to the congregation on the Sunday *Esto mihi*, etc., that henceforth on the Sundays in Lent, after the midday sermon, the examination shall be held with the children and household servants; wherefore the parents shall send and hold their children and servants thereto, that they may give account of their faith out of their catechism.

There was no daily Lenten Mass. The orders hold the Supper when there are communicants (§12.10.9). In Lent the extra services are sermons, catechism and examination.

The Lenten catechism course is treated in Chapter 15, §15.11.1, and the catechism service in Chapter 10, §10.10.

12.12.4 Holy Week

Maundy Thursday and Good Friday. The two days kept their themes: the institution of the Supper and the Passion. In Hamburg the morning service on Maundy Thursday was held "as on a Sunday, with the ceremonies", with a sermon on the sacrament. On Good Friday the Passion was preached. **Hamburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1556** (Sehling 5, p. 544):

In Lent, on Maundy Thursday, every pastor shall preach at eight o'clock of the sacrament of the body and blood of the Lord Christ; for in the forenoon it shall be held in the church as otherwise on a Sunday, with the ceremonies, as hath been done until now. On Good Friday every pastor shall preach the Passion of the Lord at eight o'clock; yet it shall be free to every pastor to begin the same in Lent, when he pleaseth, to treat it long or short.

Most orders keep Maundy Thursday and Good Friday as holy days, at least in the forenoon (§12.6.2). The old Holy Week ceremonies (palms, the ass, the grave, the Easter fire) were abolished (§12.10.10). Weddings were not held in Holy Week (§12.12.6).

12.12.5 Rogation week and the catechism seasons

Processions abolished. The Rogation processions through the fields (*Kreuzgänge*, *Bittgänge*) went with the other processions (§12.10.10), and the *Hagelfeier* (hail holiday) against hail was condemned (§12.11.4).

The week kept for the catechism. Bugenhagen kept Rogation week (*Krützeweke*) as one of four seasons for preaching the catechism through in eight sermons, by the superintendent and his adjutor. During these weeks the other preachers rested from their weekday sermons. **Braunschweig, *Kirchenordnung*, 1528** (Sehling 6/1, p. 378):

In Advent two weeks, on Monday, Tuesday, Thursday and Friday. In the first two full weeks of Lent likewise. In Rogation week with the week following likewise, except the Lord's Ascension Day. Two weeks after the harvest, before the hops are taken down, likewise. Therefore the two preachers must frame the catechism briefly and understandably for the simple, that it can be preached through in the eight sermons.

Hamburg 1529 and Lübeck 1531 repeat the plan (Sehling 5, pp. 505, 352). The four catechism seasons stand where the Ember weeks had stood (§12.12.7).

12.12.6 Closed seasons: no weddings in Advent and Lent

The old rule kept. Most orders kept the medieval closed seasons for weddings: Advent, Lent (often from mid-Lent) and the high feasts. They gave a new reason: the wedding feast would draw people from the sermon. **Schwäbisch Hall, *Kirchenordnung*, 1543** (Sehling 17/1, p. 155):

Weddings shall not be laid and held on the high feasts, as on Christmas, Easter, Whitsuntide, etc., nor yet in Advent and in Lent, especially after mid-Lent, that the people be not thereby led away from the preaching of God's word and the holy service

Strasbourg states the closed seasons exactly and adds that "we do not distinguish the times after the popish, superstitious manner". **Strasbourg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1598** (Sehling 20/1, p. 636):

Although we do not distinguish the times after the popish, superstitious manner, yet, because everything hath its time, and the devotion of the greater number shall not be hindered by the joy and pastime of a few, it is the custom with us that from the third Sunday of Advent until the first Sunday after New Year's day no weddings are accepted to be proclaimed or blessed; likewise also not from *Laetare* or mid-Lent until Easter.

The same ban, with dispensations "for great causes", is in Saxony 1580, the Upper Palatinate 1579, Grubenhagen 1581, Lüneburg 1575, Stendal 1551, Marienhafe (East Frisia) 1593 and Oldenburg (Sehling 1, p. 436; 13, p. 316; 6/2, p. 1065; 6/1, p. 672; 3, p. 316; 7/1, p. 718; 7/2.1, p. 1180). Mansfeld extended it to the octaves of the high feasts (§12.11.3). Hoya forbade weddings and other feasting through Lent and Holy Week, "that every one may prepare himself by a sober, moderate life" for the memory of Christ's passion (Sehling 6/2, p. 1200).

12.12.7 The Ember days: from fast days to quarter days

The fast gone, the date kept. The Ember days (*Quatember*, *Fronfasten*, Low German *quatertemper*) were the Wednesday, Friday and Saturday after Invocavit, Whitsunday, Holy Cross (14 September) and St Lucy (13 December). The orders do not keep them as fasts (§12.13). They keep them as the four quarter days of the church year. Their uses in the orders:

- **Payments.** The communicants' offering penny was paid "every Ember time", as were schoolmasters' fees, salaries and poor-relief accounts. This is the commonest use by far.
- **Catechism sermons.** The catechism was preached through in each Ember season. **Torgau, *Ordnung der Visitatoren*, 1529** (Sehling 1, p. 676):

The catechism shall be preached four times a year, namely in the four Ember seasons. Each Ember season two or three weeks shall be taken for it, and while the catechism lasteth the other sermons shall rest.

- **The Litany.** Albertine Saxony had the Litany sung "on the four Ember seasons for a week" (Sehling 1, p. 272), and Mansfeld "especially on the four Ember days, when the people are together" (Sehling 2, p. 239).
- **Ordinations.** In Pomerania candidates were examined and ordained "at the time of the Ember days, especially in Lent and at Michaelmas, when the catechism is repeated", so that the ordinands might hear how the catechism was preached. **Pomerania, *Kerckenordeninge*, 1569** (Sehling 4, p. 395):

The examination in doctrine shall be done out of the *Examen ordinandorum*, the *loci communes*, the catechism and the text of holy Scripture, and that at the time of the Ember days, especially in Lent and at Michaelmas, when the catechism is repeated, that the ordinands may straightway hear the form of preaching the catechism.

- **Ordinances read from the pulpit.** The forbidden degrees of marriage and the list of offences to be reported were read from the pulpit at every Ember season in Nassau (Sehling 10, pp. 95, 115). The Pfalz-Neuburg edicts were to be read "four times a year at the Ember times" (Sehling 13, p. 115).
- **Marriage sermons.** Henneberg 1582 held a half-hour sermon on marriage on the Sunday after each Ember season (Sehling 2, p. 314).

12.13 Fasting

The medieval Church kept about 160 fast and abstinence days a year (Sehling's note, Sehling 11, p. 92):

- the forty days of Lent, on the weekdays from Ash Wednesday to Holy Saturday;
- the Friday abstinence, and in many places the Saturday;
- the Ember days;
- the vigils of the great feasts.

On these days meat, and in Lent also eggs and dairy, were forbidden on pain of mortal sin. The evangelical orders removed the obligation, kept the praise of fasting, and replaced the fixed fasts with occasional days of fasting and prayer. This section covers the principle (§12.13.1), the call to voluntary fasting (§12.13.2), the orders that kept the old fasts (§12.13.3), fasts kept for civil reasons (§12.13.4), the days of fasting and prayer (§12.13.5) and fasting before communion (§12.13.6).

12.13.1 Not a law, and not a merit

Fasting set among human ordinances. The visitors of 1528 list "appointed fasts, eating no flesh on Friday" among the ordinances made "to earn grace for sins", which may therefore "be let fall" (see Chapter 10 §10.3.4 for the passage). Eating meat on Friday is "right before God and in the conscience", and less needful to preach than the commandments (§12.11.1).

Fasting good in itself. The Lüneburg articles of 1527 put the evangelical teaching in one sentence. Fasting is "useful and good, to tame the body". But it is not to be kept so that anything is earned "by difference of food on appointed days". No pastor is to compel anyone "to a difference of times or of food"; the people are to be led to "a willing fasting and a moderate life". **Lüneburg, *Artikelbuch*, 1527** (Sehling 6/1, p. 500):

The eighth article. How one shall conduct himself in fasting. Forasmuch as fasting is useful and good to tame the body, yet not to be so kept that by difference of food on appointed days anything special be merited, or God's displeasure incurred if one kept it not; but since Christ and his apostles, and also for a long time thereafter the common Christian church, left it free, [it is ordered] that every pastor compel no one to a difference of times or of food, but rather instruct them in the will of God, that it is left free to them to eat in the name of the Lord what God granteth them; yet, with constant urging of God's word, he shall meet ignorance and wantonness, that they fall not into excess, but rather take up a willing fasting and a moderate life.

"Who ever taught that Christians should not fast?" The Calenberg order of 1542 answers the charge that the evangelicals "teach nothing but to gorge on flesh". The answer has four points. Fasting is to last the whole of life, not to be bound to fixed times. It is not to be drawn into justification. It is not to be commanded on pain of mortal sin. And the difference of foods is not to be suffered, "because Christ hath freed us from such ordinances". **Calenberg-Göttingen, *Kirchenordnung*, 1542** (Sehling 6/2, p. 772):

for who hath ever taught or written that Christians should not fast? We teach what right fasting is; item, that according to the doctrine of Paul such fasting is not bound to any fixed time, but shall last the time of our life; item, that such a work must not be drawn into justification, nor be commanded on pain of a mortal sin, to ensnare the consciences therewith; item, that the difference of food cannot be suffered here, because Christ hath freed us from such ordinances

The Mecklenburg *Klosterordnung* of 1572 and the Braunschweig-Wolfenbüttel *Klosterordnung* of 1569 explain the old fish days as a piece of the monastic "house order", which had wrongly been turned into "a special service of God" (Sehling 5, p. 252; 6/1, p. 307).

12.13.2 Fasting exhorted, but free

The transitional orders. The earliest orders of the 1520s and 1530s keep the old fast days as a recommended custom. They tell the preachers to exhort the people to keep them, and to live moderately every day, but they forbid any command under the ban or mortal sin. **Brandenburg-Ansbach-Kulmbach, *Landtagsabschied*, 1526** (Sehling 11, pp. 92–93):

Of fasting and eating flesh. The pastors and preachers shall exhort the people that they live not only in the forty days' fast, the Ember days and the other fast days kept hitherto, but daily in moderation and abstinence, or without excess of eating and drinking, that they may tame their fleshly bodies and make them fit to fulfil and practise God's will and work [...]. And whereas, by the ordinance of certain holy fathers and councils, men have for a long time abstained on the appointed fast days from flesh, eggs and other things, to the praise and honour of God, although without doubt it was not the meaning of the same holy fathers and councils thereby to put any one in danger of his soul or body, or to lay a snare of sin, or to make a new mortal sin, but rather therewith to further men to Christian chastening of their body

Nassau-Dillenburg 1537 and Jülich-Kleve 1525 (Roman Catholic humanist) have the same text (Sehling 10, p. 77; 21, p. 71).

Before the Supper. Oldenburg 1573, following Urbanus Rhegius, asks why Christians will not fast "once or twice in the year" before coming to the Lord's table, when "the first godly Christendom a thousand years ago kept the forty fast days, each according to his occasion". **Oldenburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1573** (Sehling 7/2.1, p. 1081):

Also, when he will ask anything earnest of God, or will prepare himself for an earnest thanksgiving in the Lord's Supper, he will beforehand, by the moving of the Spirit of Christ, fast, or live moderately and soberly. If he do it not, he is yet wholly carnal and a Christian in name. The first godly Christendom a thousand years ago kept the forty fast days, each one according to his occasion. What manner of Christians are we, that we will not fast once or twice in the year, when we are to go to God's table?

12.13.3 Orders that kept the old fasts

Waldeck 1528 and Baden. A few orders kept the fasts as before. The articles for the Waldeck synod at Mengeringhausen in 1528 say "all fast days shall be kept as hitherto", with abstinence from meat "at the forbidden times". **Waldeck, *Beschlüsse für die Synode von Mengeringhausen*, 1528** (Sehling 9, p. 185):

All fast days shall be kept as hitherto. One shall abstain from eating flesh at the forbidden times. Sunday, the apostles' days, Our Lady's days, etc., shall be kept holy for the Word's sake, but yet in the time of harvest, etc., no one's conscience shall be burdened.

The Margrave Philipp of Baden, in his mandate of 1531, still required "the forty days and other fast days brought down in the common Christian church, together with the Fridays and Saturdays", with abstinence from meat except in need or bodily weakness (Sehling 16, p. 507). The Colmar council, still Catholic (the city's Reformation came in 1575), complained in 1560 that the Lenten fast and "other fast days through the year" were kept with little discretion "among young and old, sick and healthy" (Sehling's introduction, Sehling 20/2, p. 481).

12.13.4 Fasting by police order

Meat days for the price of meat. Where a magistrate ordered abstinence, the reason given was economic, and the order says so. The Nordhausen police order of 1549 forbids meat on Fridays, Saturdays and in Lent because the price of meat was rising. The old, the sick, hard labourers, young children and women in childbed are exempt. It declares that no one is to think it a sin. **Nordhausen, *Polizei-Ordnung der Stadt Nordhausen*, 1549** (Sehling 2, p. 396):

Of eating flesh and of Lent. And whereas we find that the buying of flesh groweth ever more into great dearness, we will that every one abstain from eating flesh two days in the week, Fridays and Saturdays, and also in Lent; excepted old [and] sick people, hard labourers, young children, women in childbed, or those to whom it is allowed at the bidding of the physicians; yet so that no wantonness or abuse be sought herein. Yet shall this article be understood by no one as though it were sin and forbidden by God not to eat flesh at the aforesaid time, which is in no wise meant by us; but we will let all that the Lord God hath left free and without sin to be used remain free and without sin, and herein have sought and meant nothing else than obedience and good order, police and moderation.

The fish market. Strasbourg's Sunday mandate (1534, Moderate Reformed) lets milk and bread be sold before the sermon, "and in Lent the fish" (Sehling 20/1, p. 246; §12.11.2). Lent still governed the market.

12.13.5 Days of fasting and prayer

The new fast day. In place of the fixed fasts, the orders appoint days of fasting and prayer (*Buß-*, *Bett-* and *Fasttage*) in times of war, plague, dearth and threat to the church. Some were monthly, some extraordinary. On them feasting and weddings were stopped, and the people were called to fasting as well as prayer. The Palatine mandate of 1610 (Reformed), issued as the Catholic League formed, tells the preachers to teach that "at dangerous, sorrowful times even permitted joys are to be laid aside". It also tells them to correct the false idea that "with the popish superstitious fasting the rightful Christian fasting also was done away". **Kurpfalz, *Mandat zu den Bußtagen*, 1610** (Reformed; Sehling 19/2, p. 971):

1. How that at dangerous, sorrowful times even the permitted joys are to be laid aside. 2. Of the custom of the church of God, to prepare itself by fasting and chastening of the body for earnest prayer; wherein the false conceit is to be taken from them, as though with the popish superstitious fasting the rightful Christian fasting were also done away.

A Nassau-Weilburg text printed with the order of 1576 makes the monthly prayer days fast days, on which betrothal feasts, guild banquets and all weddings in the week were stopped (Sehling 10, p. 239). Hesse (Moderate Reformed) and Schleswig-Holstein ordered prayer days with fasting in the 1550s and 1560s (Sehling 8, p. 263; 23, p. 270). Kurland mentions extraordinary "fast days" set by edict in time of war (Sehling 5, p. 92).

Fasting at the choice of ministers. The Hessian order of 1566 (Moderate Reformed) and the Reformed orders follow Acts 13 and 14: the church is to prepare "with fasting and prayer" for the election of a superintendent or minister. **Micron, *Christliche Ordinancien* (1554; German edition 1565)** (Reformed; Sehling 7/1, p. 588):

When the congregation is in need of one minister or more, then, according to the ordinance of God, a common, certain fast day is appointed by the elders, which day is thereafter proclaimed from the pulpit to the whole congregation

The Hessian rule (Moderate Reformed) is at Sehling 8, p. 203, and the same provision is in Pfalz-Veldenz 1574 (Sehling 18, p. 560).

The prayer-day sermons are treated in Chapter 11, §11.4.5, and the Litany days in Chapter 13, §13.21.4.

12.13.6 Fasting before communion

Sober for the sacrament. The one fast the orders still expected regularly was the communicant's. The Hessian order of 1566 (Moderate Reformed) defends receiving the sacrament fasting with Augustine: "it hath pleased the Holy Ghost that, in honour of this most worthy sacrament, the body of the Lord should enter the Christian's mouth before other food" (Sehling 8, p. 309). The Saxon order of 1580 forbids banquets on the eves of Sundays and feasts, so that the household might come to the sacrament sober. **Albertine Saxony, *Ordnung* of Duke August, 1580** (Sehling 1, p. 430):

They shall therefore not only do away with all banquets on the eves of Sundays and high feasts, but also every householder shall hold his whole household to a sober life, chiefly when they go to the most worthy sacrament, that they may hear God's word soberly, with delight and devotion, on the following Sunday or feast day, [and] use the communion worthily

Who fasted, and how. The orders give no general fasting rules for clergy or laity. What they show:

- **Communicants.** Communicants were expected to come fasting and to keep the eve soberly (§12.13.6 above).
- **Everyone on prayer days.** The whole congregation was called to fast on the appointed days of fasting and prayer, and to give up feasts and weddings (§12.13.5).
- **Under police orders.** Where the magistrate ordered abstinence for economic reasons, the old, the sick, labourers, children and women in childbed were exempt (§12.13.4).
- **No separate clergy fast.** No order lays a separate fast on the clergy. The monastic fasts went with the monastic rules: Württemberg's convent order of 1535 counts the bonds of human ordinances "in fasting, silence, confessing, wearing cowls and tonsures" among what is cast off (Sehling 16, p. 79).

Confession and communion as a duty of the laity are treated in Chapter 15, §15.8.3.

12.14 Occurrence and transfer

The medieval rubrics had detailed tables of "occurrence" (two feasts on the same day) and "concurrence" (the vespers of one feast meeting the first vespers of the next). A feast of higher grade displaced one of lower grade, which was commemorated or transferred. The Lutheran orders keep the principle, but apply it to three practical cases:

- a feast that falls on a Sunday;
- the Annunciation in Holy Week;
- a lesser feast that falls on a Saturday, or in the same week as another.

Their rules show how the ranks of §12.5 were understood: Sunday against feast, feast of Christ against Passiontide, apostle against working week.

12.14.1 A feast on a Sunday

The general rule is that a feast of Christ displaces the Sunday Gospel, while an apostles' day yields to it.

Rostock, *Conformitas ceremoniarum*, c. 1560 (Sehling 5, p. 288):

But if great feasts fall on the Sunday, as Christmas, St Stephen, St John the Evangelist, New Year's, the Three Kings, the Purification of Mary, the Annunciation of Mary, John the Baptist, the Visitation of Mary and Michaelmas, one shall keep the Gospels of the feasts. […] 7. But when the apostles' feasts fall on the Sunday, one shall keep the Sunday Gospels, and preach the Gospels that fall on the apostles' feasts in the afternoon.

Note. St Stephen and St John count here as "great feasts", as days of Christmas, while the apostles do not.

Mansfeld sets out the apostles' days by the day of the week on which they fall. **Mansfeld, *Kirchen-agenda*, 1580** (Sehling 2, p. 240):

If an apostle's day fall on a Sunday, it may be kept as it falleth; yet so that in the towns, in the churches where there is preaching two or three times on Sunday, the Sunday Gospel also be expounded in one of the same sermons. If an apostle's day fall on a Monday, Tuesday, Wednesday, Thursday or Friday, it may be kept in the towns on the day whereon it falleth, as is customary; but where it is customary to remove it to the next following day whereon the week-day sermons are otherwise held, it may abide by that custom. But if an apostle's day fall on a Saturday, it shall be removed to the next following Sunday, and kept thereon.

Note.

- **Wintzingerode.** The order (Sehling 2, p. 256) has the same rules. There the apostle's Gospel goes to the Sunday afternoon.
- **Thorn 1575.** Small feasts falling near a Sunday go to its vespers (§12.5.6).
- **Danzig 1612.** A small feast falling on a Sunday is rung like a great one (§12.5.6).
- **Nördlingen 1579.** A local thanksgiving day falling on a Sunday is to be kept "solemnly, as other high feasts" (Sehling 12, p. 388).

12.14.2 The Annunciation in Holy Week

The Annunciation (25 March) often falls between Palm Sunday and Low Sunday. The orders count it as a feast of Christ. It cannot simply be dropped, and it may not displace the Passion and Easter. The orders give at least six solutions:

Solution	Orders
The Saturday before Palm Sunday (*Palmabend*)	Hadersleben 1528; Schleswig-Holstein 1542; Merseburg 1544; Anhalt 1568; Pomerania 1569; Sayn 1582
Palm Sunday itself, in the forenoon	Aschersleben 1575; Schwarzburg 1587; Wintzingerode (only if it falls Wednesday to Saturday, "per anticipationem" [by anticipation])
A weekday of the week before Palm Sunday	Waldeck 1556 (Wednesday after Judica); Hoya 1571 and Harlingerland 1573/74 (Thursday after Judica)
The Sunday after Easter ("according to old custom")	Prussia 1526, 1544 and 1568
Maundy Thursday	Burzenland chapter, 1573 (a proposal of the dean for that year)
Omitted that year	Ysenburg 1582
A convenient day agreed with the neighbouring churches	Thorn 1575

Hadersleben, *Artikel*, 1528 (Sehling 23, p. 64):

Our Lady's Annunciation day (and when it falleth on Maundy Thursday or thereafter, it shall be kept with one accord on the Saturday before Palm Sunday; otherwise it shall not be transferred)

Merseburg, *Synodalunterricht*, 1544 (Sehling 2, p. 20):

But as touching the removing of the feasts: that the Annunciation of Mary, if it should fall in the week of the Passion, be laid on the eve of Palm Sunday. The removing of the other feasts shall be determined by the consistory, and shown to the parsons in the synods by the superintendent.

Pomerania, *Agenda*, 1569 (Sehling 4, p. 469):

When the day of the Annunciation of Mary falleth in the still week, be it what day it be, one shall lay the feast on the eve of Palm Sunday, and bid the same beforehand on the Sunday Judica.

Wintzingerode (Gericht Bodenstein), *Kirchen-Ordnung* (Sehling 2, p. 256):

If the feast of the Annunciation of Mary fall in the week of the Passion on a Monday or Tuesday, it shall be kept on the same. But if it fall on the Wednesday, Maundy Thursday, Good Friday or Easter Eve, one shall keep it holy (as the ancients call it) *per*

anticipationem, back upon Palm Sunday.

Note. *Per anticipationem* (By anticipation) is the old term for moving a feast back, before its date. "As the ancients call it" shows that the orders knew they were using the medieval rules of transfer.

Schwarzburg, *Ordnung der fest und feiertage*, 1587 (Sehling 2, p. 137):

But if the feast of the Annunciation, as sometimes happeneth, fell in the week of the Passion, it shall be laid on Palm Sunday and kept solemnly in the forenoon, but the Gospel of the same Sunday be preached in the afternoon

Waldeck, *Kirchenordnung*, 1556 (Sehling 9, p. 272):

But this feast shall be kept (to avoid offensive inequality) on the Wednesday after Judica, when it falleth on Palm Sunday or in Palm week; otherwise it shall be kept on the day whereon it cometh

Prussia, *Kirchenordnung und Ceremonien*, 1568 (Sehling 4, p. 87):

When the day of the Conception of Christ or the Annunciation of Mary falleth on Palm Sunday, or in the week before Easter, or in the same following week in the Easter days, it shall be kept on the next Sunday after Easter, and be transferred according to the former church order; that the same time may be preached, without hindrance and as need requireth, of the riding in of the Lord Christ and his holy Passion, together with the history of the resurrection.

Note. The rule goes back to the Prussian order of 1526 (Sehling 4, p. 38). That order keeps the day after Easter "according to old custom", after the old custom, which is the medieval practice of transferring the Annunciation to the week after Low Sunday.

In 1573 Easter fell on 22 March, so the Annunciation fell on the Wednesday after Easter. The dean of the Burzenland chapter writes. **Burzenland chapter (Transylvania), resolutions of 25 February 1573** (Sehling 24, p. 371):

6. In the old reckoning of the Church the feast of the Annunciation of Mary, or Conception of Christ, is assigned to the 25th of March, which falleth on the Wednesday after Christ's rising again, when several other feasts concur. If we celebrate it then, we shall increase gluttony and intemperance among our people. The makers of the common calendars of this year have drawn it back to the Saturday before Palm Sunday. That day is more given to profane marketing than to the celebration of feasts. I will therefore celebrate that feast on the fifth day before Easter, which is called the day of the Lord's Supper.

The Thorn order admits that practice varies. **Thorn, *Kirchenordnung*, 1575** (Sehling 4, pp. 239–240):

But because in the choosing of a convenient day it is not held alike in all places, as is to be seen in the old and new church orders, it is surest and also most convenient that one agree with the churches and towns lying round about and near, to keep the feast with them on one day, though they do not […] all agree with us in religion; only that the weak may in some measure be cared for.

12.14.3 Saturdays, harvests and two feasts in one week

Henneberg gives a rule for the "common feasts" of the second rank. **Henneberg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1582** (Sehling 2, p. 313):

But if a common feast should fall on a Sunday, the Gospel appointed for the same Sunday shall be preached as usual, the feast proclaimed, and it shall be shewn to the people that the history or Gospel of the feast is removed to be preached on the next following Wednesday. But if two or more common feasts fall in one week, the first shall be kept on the day whereon it falleth; but the history or Gospel of the other shall be orderly handled on the following Wednesday of the next week; and this nevertheless shall always be proclaimed on the Sunday before.

Aschersleben, *Kirchen-Agenda*, 1575 (Sehling 2, p. 479):

But when the feast falleth on a Saturday, it is removed until the Sunday afternoon. Also, because the day of James the apostle cometh in the harvest, it is the custom, when it falleth on a Friday or Saturday, to handle the feast on the next Sunday after, in the afternoon.

In Schwarzburg apostles' days are not moved, except from a Saturday. **Schwarzburg, *Ordnung der fest und feiertage*, 1587** (Sehling 2, p. 137):

the feasts of the apostles shall be kept solemnly, without omission and without any removing, on the day whereon they fall; in the forenoon also the organs, where there be any, shall be used […] yet when such an apostle's feast falleth on a Saturday, it shall follow on the Sunday after, at vespers, and be kept then

12.14.4 Moving not allowed

Against these rules for moving feasts, several orders forbid pastors to move feasts on their own authority, whether for markets or to save themselves work.

Salzwedel (Altstadt), *Visitations-Abschied*, 1579 (Sehling 3, p. 275):

therefore the visitors ordain that the parson and chaplains here shall keep the feast days on the days whereon they fall, according to the church and visitation orders, in Christian manner and solemnly, and not put them off or remove them at their pleasure, nor leave out any feast, notwithstanding they should fall on the market days

Sayn, *Kirchenordnung*, 1590 (Sehling 19/1, p. 389):

Neither shall any parson have power to remove the same feasts or holy days to other days, but he shall content himself to keep them holy on the days whereon they fall, that no inequality be held, to offence and evil report, etc.

The Kosd and Schelken statutes continue after the sentence quoted in §12.3.7. **Kosd and Schelken chapters (Transylvania), statutes, 1577** (Sehling 24, p. 400):

But if any, to please his peasants, shall have celebrated any feast day which is not in the catalogue of feasts, or shall have put off a feast to be celebrated on another day, he shall be punished with the chapter's penalty

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12.15 The short calendars: Upper German towns and the Reformed

At the other end from the conservative lists of §12.5.7 stand the orders that kept only Sunday and a handful of high feasts. In these the question of rank hardly arises: there is Sunday, and there are the few feasts of Christ that remain. They are mostly Upper German cities under Zwinglian or Bucerian influence (Reformed or Moderate Reformed), and later Reformed territories. Their history shows how unstable the minimum was.

Mülhausen's first step (Reformed) keeps four "high-tides" with the Marian feasts and the apostles, and abolishes the local and lesser days. Among them is "the octave of St Stephen", the only octave named in any list of abolished feasts. **Mülhausen (Alsace), council decree on processions and holy days, 1524** (Reformed; Sehling 20/2, p. 196):

This and other things considered, it is ordained that henceforth men shall honour and keep first the holy Sunday, and thereto the high feasts, the four high-tides, our dear Lady's days and the apostles' days, as the custom is. But these days hereafter appointed, by name: the Children's day, the eighth day of St Stephen, Mark, the two holy Cross days, the Emperor Henry […] Magdalene, St Stephen in August, Laurence, the cold church-hallowing, Gallus, Luke, Catherine, Nicholas, Easter Wednesday and Whitsun Wednesday: these shall all henceforth be no more commanded to be kept holy, nor held for holy days; but nevertheless their memory shall be kept on each day in the church, first with the proclaiming of God's Word and thereafter with the offices of the mass, as the custom is

Note. The "cold church-hallowing" (*kalte kilby*) is the dedication feast of Basel Minster, 11 October. The "four high-tides" at Mülhausen are Christmas, Easter, Ascension and Pentecost (see the next quotation).

Five years later Mülhausen adopted the Basel order (both Reformed). **Mülhausen, opinion on the Basel and Strasbourg orders, 1529** (Reformed; Sehling 20/2, pp. 214–215):

Item, with the holy days it shall be kept after the Basel order, which hath ordained to keep holy no more than Christmas day, Ascension day, Easter day and Whitsunday, together with the Sundays.

Augsburg, *Feiertagsordnung* of the council, 22 July 1537 (Moderate Reformed; Sehling 12, p. 84):

therefore the council hath considered and resolved that henceforth only the Sundays (and every Saturday evening, to begin at three of the clock after midday), likewise Christmas day, Easter day and Whitsunday (without any after-holiday), […] thereto New Year's day, the day of the Ascension of Christ and the day of the Annunciation of Mary, be kept holy; whereby all and every other

holy day here, none excepted, shall hereby be taken away, so that every man may on all and every other day, beside the holy days aforesaid, well work and seek his living in the sweat of his face.

Note. "without any after-holiday", abolishes the second and third days of the great feasts. The Saturday evening, from three o'clock, is treated as part of the Sunday.

The Esslingen council (Moderate Reformed) first abolished everything but Sunday and Christmas (22a), then brought the apostles' days back (22b). **Esslingen, council decrees of 1537** (Moderate Reformed; Sehling 17/2, pp. 389–390):

But forasmuch as an honourable council perceiveth that on such holy days the common people are more given to open carousing and other lightness than to the preaching of the divine Word; that such evil, which ariseth out of idleness, may be put down, and every man drawn to his daily work, an honourable council hath wholly done away all holy days, beside the holy Sunday and Christmas day, and willeth that none of the same be kept holy any more, but that every man betake himself on such days to his daily work. [...] and now it is found plainly that on the "good Mondays", even as heretofore on the holy days, all drunkenness and unchastity have their course, especially among the young folk, while no time nor leisure can be given to the wholesome Word of God alone [...] therefore their honourable wisdom, for these causes aforesaid and more other weighty causes, ordaineth and willeth that henceforth, beside the commanded Sundays, the holy apostles' days be kept holy again, and God's Word be preached and heard thereon

Note. The "good Mondays" were the "blue Mondays" that craftsmen took off. The Esslingen council learned that abolishing holy days did not abolish holidays, and restored the apostles' days in order to have days for preaching.

At Strasbourg (1544, Moderate Reformed) only Sunday is a holy day in the city. The saints are remembered in the sermon, and the countryside may keep its half and whole days. **Strasbourg, synodal decrees, 1544** (Moderate Reformed; Sehling 20/1, pp. 342–343):

Because in the city only the Sunday is kept holy, the preachers shall oft and with all earnestness exhort the people that they hallow such rest wholly unto the Lord. They shall also on the same [Sundays], when the days fall in the week whereon otherwise memorials and holy days are kept of the chief works of God which he hath wrought in his dear Son, or also in the apostles and martyrs, set forth to the people the memorials and histories of the same, when they are had in the Scripture or else in approved books [...] But where in the country such memorials still have their holy day, the whole or the half day, there they shall be kept in Christian wise.

The Nassau-Dillenburg order after the county turned Reformed. **Nassau-Dillenburg (Reformed), *Kirchenordnung*, 1582** (Sehling 10, p. 163):

48. Let all feasts of the saints and the abuses of holy days be abrogated, and let the Lord's days only and the feasts of Christ be retained.

Note. The same county's Lutheran order of 1537 had kept Corpus Christi, the Assumption and the Nativity of Mary (§12.5.7, §12.8.9).

The Palatine order of 1556 had followed Württemberg (§12.5.3). Its Reformed successor keeps only the three great feasts, New Year and Ascension. **Kurpfalz (Reformed), *Kirchenordnung*, 1563** (Sehling 14, p. 397):

Order of the holy days. On the holy days it shall be done as on Sunday. But these holy days shall be kept: all Sundays; Christmas day with the next day after; New Year's day; Easter day with the next day after; the Ascension of Christ; Whitsunday with the Monday following after.

Note. The editor notes that the 1556 order "had besides: Epiphany, the Marian and apostles' days, John the Baptist and Michaelmas".

When Anhalt turned Reformed, the prince ordered a new agenda on the Palatine model. **Anhalt, Prince Johann Georg to the superintendent, 4 March 1599** (Reformed; Sehling 2, p. 535):

to draw up a general agenda for the churches of this principality, directed upon and after the Palatine one and conformable to the same; and that therein the apostles' and other feasts be discontinued, and in the three chief feasts no more than two days be kept holy, but the third be wholly abolished

Note. With these reductions, the ranking of §12.5 falls back to the two ranks of Luther's *Formula missae* (Form of the Mass): Sunday and the feasts of the Lord.

12.16 Concordance of the orders quoted

Every order quoted or cited in this chapter is listed below by region. The table gives:

- **Sehling**: the volume and pages in Sehling's edition.
- **Doc**: the `eko.db` document that holds the text, for full-text lookup. Note that a single database record may hold several orders.
- **Notes**: a short description of the order's system, or of what it contributes to the chapter.
- **§**: the sections where the order is quoted.

Luther; Saxony and Thuringia

Order	Sehling	Doc	Notes	§
Wittenberg, Luther, *Formula missae*, 1523	1, pp. 5, 9	2	two ranks: Sundays and "feasts of the Lord"; saints' feasts abolished or folded into Sunday preaching; Purification and Annunciation counted as feasts of Christ; Holy Cross "anathema"	12.3.1, 12.4.3, 12.12.1
Saxony (Ernestine), *Unterricht der Visitatoren*, 1528	1, pp. 164–169	9	feasts of Christ "in particular"; Marian, John, Michael, apostles, Magdalene desirable where not fallen away; Latin on high feasts	12.3.4, 12.5.2, 12.10.1, 12.11.1, 12.13.1
Amt Grimma, *Generalia*, 1529	1, p. 576	90	high feasts three days, with vestments	12.7.1
Amt Leisnig, *Verordnung*, 1529	1, p. 610	105	three high feasts three days, *festive* (festally)	12.4.5
Ernestine Saxony, *Gemeine Verordnung*, 1533	1, p. 192	14	Latin Mass on high feasts in towns	12.10.1
Altenburg castle chapter, 1533	1, p. 516	56	more bells on Sundays and feasts	12.10.7
Saxony (Albertine), *Kirchenordnung*, 1539	1, p. 274	30	high chief feasts of Christ (incl. Purification, Annunciation, Maundy Thursday, Good Friday); then John, Visitation, Michael; apostles forenoon or moved to Sunday	12.3.7, 12.5.2
Merseburg, *Synodalunterricht*, 1544	2, p. 20	1211	whole-day feasts; forenoon feasts "without a commanded holy day" (Maundy Thursday, Good Friday, apostles); Annunciation to Palm eve	12.5.2, 12.14.2
Burg, *Kirchen-Ordnung*, 1542	2, p. 427	1257	vespers and sermon *in vigiliis* of high feasts	12.4.6
Gera (Plauen extract), 1556	2, pp. 158–159	1234	feasts of Christ and apostles with Gospel histories; Stephen and John as Christmas days	12.3.7
Penig, *Kirchenordnung*, 1575	1, p. 634	116	high feasts: 3, 2, 1 sermons on successive days	12.6.3
Schwarzburg, *Ordnung der fest und feiertage*, 1587	2, p. 137	1230	three chief feasts three days (third forenoon only); seven feasts whole day *solenniter* (solemnly); apostles forenoon, not moved	12.7.1, 12.14.2, 12.14.3

Order	Sehling	Doc	Notes	§
Henneberg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1582	2, pp. 312–313, 314	1247	four chief feasts incl. Ascension, two sermons; "common feasts" one sermon, no organ; rules for occurrence	12.6.3, 12.12.7, 12.14.3
Goldlauter (Henneberg), 1566	2, p. 333	1248	Christmas three days, Easter and Whitsun two	12.7.2
Luther, *Deutsche Messe und ordnung gottis diensts*, 1526	1, p. 16	3	Holy Week "as other weeks"	12.12.1
Saxony (Albertine), *Kirchenordnunge zum anfang*, 1539	1, p. 272	30	Litany on the four Ember seasons	12.12.7
Allstedt, *Ordnung der Visitatoren*, 1533	1, p. 511	53	catechism examined in Advent, Lent and after harvest	12.12.2
Gotha, visitation articles, 1555	1, p. 569	88	daily catechism in Lent in place of the *Salve Regina*	12.12.3
Torgau, *Ordnung der Visitatoren*, 1529	1, p. 676	139	catechism in the four Ember seasons	12.12.7
Saxony (Albertine), *Ordnung* of Duke August, 1580	1, pp. 424, 430, 436	44	Lenten examinations; sober eves before communion; no weddings in Advent and Lent	12.12.3, 12.12.6, 12.13.6

Harz counties, Magdeburg and Halberstadt, Anhalt

Order	Sehling	Doc	Notes	§
Mansfeld, *Kirchen-agenda*, 1580	2, pp. 239–240	1241	whole days and half days listed; apostles by day of the week; harvest apostles moved; no weddings at chief feasts	12.6.2, 12.6.4, 12.11.3, 12.12.7, 12.14.1
Wintzingerode (after Hohnstein), undated	2, p. 256	1243	whole days two sermons, third day of chief feasts one; half days; Annunciation *per anticipationem* (by anticipation)	12.6.2, 12.14.2
Aschersleben, *Kirchen-Agenda*, 1575	2, pp. 479–480	1260	three chief feasts; eight "middle" feasts as Sundays, figural; apostles forenoon, *Kyrie apostolicum* (apostles' Kyrie)	12.5.5, 12.10.2, 12.14.3
Ermsleben, *Kirchen-Ordnung*, 1564	2, p. 486	1260	high feasts whole day, two sermons; apostles forenoon	12.6.2
Anhalt, Nicolaus Hausmann's order, 1532	2, p. 542	1262	one wide list incl. Corpus Christi, Conception, Assumption, Nativity of Mary; apostles forenoon; night vigil of Christmas and Easter wished for	12.4.6, 12.5.7
Anhalt, *Ordnung der deutschen Gesänge*, 1551	2, pp. 554–555	1262	high feasts / other Sundays and feasts / weekdays *ferialiter* (in the ferial manner; no *Gloria*)	12.4.5
Hatzkerode (Anhalt), 1534(?)	2, p. 587	1263	preface on great feasts, exhortation otherwise	12.10.3
Anhalt, *Kirchenordnung* of Prince Bernhard, 1568	2, pp. 569–570	1262	apostles, John, Magdalene, Purification, Annunciation, Michael kept; Visitation and Nativity of Mary *ferialiter*;	12.4.5, 12.7.1, 12.10.6

Order	Sehling	Doc	Notes	§
			high feasts two days figural, third Latin chorale; elevation on high feasts	
Anhalt, Prince Johann Georg, 1599 (Reformed)	2, p. 535	1261	Reformed: apostles' and other feasts discontinued; high feasts two days only	12.15
Wasungen (Henneberg), *Kirchen-Ordnung*, 1566	2, pp. 356–357	1250	"loose holy days" turned to work	12.11.1
Nordhausen, *Polizei-Ordnung der Stadt Nordhausen*, 1549	2, p. 396	1254	meat days for the price of meat	12.13.4

Brandenburg, Prussia, Pomerania, the Baltic, Poland and Silesia

Order	Sehling	Doc	Notes	§
Brandenburg (Electorate), *Kirchenordnung*, 1540	3, p. 87	1746	one long list incl. Corpus Christi, Assumption, Nativity of Mary, All Saints, Martin, Laurence, Catherine	12.5.7
Neumark, visitation instruction, 1540	3, p. 36	1745	collection on high feasts "not only the four times"	12.9.3
Crevese nunnery, recess, 1541	3, p. 203	1762	Office *de tempore* (of the season) and of high feasts; saints' days from the *commune sanctorum* (common of the saints)	12.4.4
Brandenburg, *Visitation- und Consistorialordnung*, 1573	3, p. 129	1748	markets on high feasts moved	12.11.3
Salzwedel (Altstadt), visitation recess, 1579	3, pp. 275, 285	1779	feasts not to be moved to Sundays or market days	12.11.2, 12.14.4
Tangermünde, *Ritus*, 1603	3, p. 338	1788	*summae festivitates* (highest festivities)	12.4.2
Prussia, *Kirchenordnung und Ceremonien*, 1568 (after 1526, 1544)	4, pp. 38, 87	1833	apostles forenoon only; Annunciation in Holy Week to the Sunday after Easter; Magdalene's Gospel on Trinity 7	12.6.1, 12.8.8, 12.14.2
Pomerania, *Kirchenordnung*, 1535	4, p. 343	1856	three great feasts three days; feasts of Christ, John, Visitation, Michael	12.5.4
Pomerania, *Kirchenordnung*, 1542	4, p. 356	1859	Kyrie grades: *summum* (the highest [chant]) on the higher feasts	12.4.2, 12.10.11
Pomerania, *Agenda*, 1569	4, pp. 466–469, 463, 473	1865	three great feasts three days, wholly kept; other feasts; apostles forenoon, *festivaliter* bells, no communion; Annunciation to Palm eve	12.10.2, 12.10.5, 12.11.5, 12.12.2, 12.14.2
Pomerania, *Kerckenordeninge*, 1569	4, pp. 414, 395	1862	the four-times penny	12.9.1, 12.12.7
Riga, *Kirchenordnung*, 1530	5, pp. 15, 17	1897	all feasts of Christ, and the Visitation; paschal Kyrie on high feasts	12.3.7, 12.10.2
Kurland, *Kirchenordnung*, 1570	5, pp. 89, 92	1907	proper German prefaces on high feasts	12.10.3, 12.13.5

Order	Sehling	Doc	Notes	§
Danzig, St Mary's, 1567, with draft *Feiertagsordnung* (holy-day order)	4, pp. 186–187	1844	feasts with four sermons and vigils; apostles, angels, Visitation two early sermons; third day disputed	12.7.1
Danzig, St Mary's, *Kirchenordnung*, 1612	4, pp. 203–204	1844	great feasts (three sermons) and small feasts (one sermon), marked by bells	12.5.6, 12.10.7
Thorn, *Kirchenordnung*, 1575	4, pp. 237–240	1844	feasts of Christ, great feasts three days; "small or half feasts" two sermons, German office; Annunciation moved by agreement	12.5.6, 12.10.1, 12.10.3, 12.14.2
Posen, Bohemian Brethren, 1576 (Bohemian Brethren)	4, p. 285	1846	Sunday first in dignity, as moral law	12.3.8
Teschen, *Kirchenordnung*, 1584	3, p. 461	1815	one long list incl. Nativity of Mary, Martin, Catherine; any may be a half day	12.5.7
Brieg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1592	3, p. 445	1809	three Marian feasts, John, Michael whole day; apostles one early sermon	12.6.2
Cölln on the Spree, *Visitations-Abschied*, 1540	3, p. 194	1759	town gates shut on holy-day mornings	12.11.2
Salzwedel (Neustadt), visitation recess, 1579; Stendal, *Visitations-Abschied*, 1578	3, pp. 300, 331	1780, 1787	town gates shut on holy-day mornings	12.11.2
Stendal, *Visitations-Abschied*, 1551	3, p. 316	1786	no weddings in Advent and Lent	12.12.6
Zittau 1564 and Herwigsdorf 1595, church orders	3, p. 379	1798	catechism daily in Lent "at Salve time"	12.12.3
Pomerania, *Karcken ordening*	4, p. 354	1858	Latin Litany when kept *dominicaliter* (in the Sunday manner), in Advent and Lent	12.10.11

The Low German north

Order	Sehling	Doc	Notes	§
Braunschweig, *Kirchenordnung* (Bugenhagen), 1528	6/1, pp. 380, 397–398, 441, 378	1983	three great feasts three days, four sermons a day; other Gospel feasts fully kept; Michaelmas a four-times feast; apostles moved to Sunday; proper prefaces; a new feast of Christ's baptism	12.3.3, 12.5.4, 12.8.5, 12.8.9, 12.10.3, 12.12.5
Hamburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1529	5, pp. 513–514, 528	1960	as Braunschweig	12.3.3, 12.5.4
Lübeck, *Kirchenordnung*, 1531	5, pp. 362, 352	1949	the four times: Easter, Whitsun, Michaelmas, Christmas	12.9.1, 12.12.5
Hamburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1556	5, p. 551	1963	figural music on the chiefest feasts	12.10.5
Ritzebüttel, *Kirchenordnung*, 1556	5, p. 559	1963	whole-day holy days; half days until noon	12.6.2
Lauenburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1585	5, p. 421	1953	"high four-times feasts"	12.9.3
Mecklenburg, *Ordeninge der misse*,	5, p. 151	1922	German *Kyrie summum*	12.4.2

Order	Sehling	Doc	Notes	§
1545				
Mecklenburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1552	5, pp. 200–201	1922	high chief feasts of Christ; "over these chiefest feasts" apostles, John, Visitation, Michael (forenoon); Michaelmas replaces Assumption as four-times feast	12.5.2, 12.8.8
Mecklenburg, *Visitations-Instruction*, 1557	5, p. 224	1925	Assumption not to be kept; Michaelmas the four-times feast	12.8.3
Rostock, *Conformitas ceremoniarum*, c. 1560	5, p. 288	1936	great feasts on Sunday displace the Sunday Gospel; apostles do not	12.14.1
Mecklenburg, *Klosterordnung*, 1572	5, pp. 252, 258	1926	fish days a monastic house-rule; Athanasian Creed on high feasts	12.10.8, 12.13.1
Hadersleben, *Artikel*, 1528	23, p. 64	1576	Latin on "groten feste" (great feasts; *summa festa*); holy days listed; apostles not kept; Annunciation to Palm eve	12.4.2, 12.14.2
Schleswig-Holstein, *Kirchenordnung*, 1542	23, pp. 90–95	1576	three great feasts three days; feasts of Christ, Assumption, Visitation, John, Michael, All Saints; apostles on Sunday; Latin and sequences on high feasts	12.3.3, 12.5.4, 12.8.5, 12.10.1, 12.10.4, 12.11.5
Hadersleben, *Zuchtordnung*, 1573	23, p. 244	1599	no guild feasts on high feasts	12.11.3
Gottorf, visitation articles, 1587	23, p. 371	1621	preface *in summis festis* (on the highest feasts)	12.4.2
Hamburg, *Kirchenordnung* (Bugenhagen), 1529	5, pp. 505, 507	1958, 1959	Shrove Sunday a feast of baptism; catechism seasons	12.11.5, 12.12.5
Hamburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1556	5, p. 544	1962	Maundy Thursday sermon on the sacrament; Good Friday Passion	12.12.4
Schleswig-Holstein, prayer days with fasting, 1553	23, p. 270	1602	prayer days and fasting	12.13.5

Lower Saxony, Westphalia and the Lower Rhine

Order	Sehling	Doc	Notes	§
Northeim, *Kirchenordnung*, 1539	6/2, pp. 934–935	2047	"chief feasts" for the weak's sake; Corpus Christi kept for civil reasons	12.3.5, 12.8.9
Wolfenbüttel, *Kirchenordnung*, 1543	6/1, pp. 62–63	1972	four times with first-vespers sermon; Stephen, John, John Baptist themes	12.7.3, 12.8.6, 12.9.3
Grubenhagen, *Kirchenordnung*, 1544	6/2, pp. 1032–1033	2056	four chief feasts (four-times penny); seven "glorious feasts"; apostles forenoon	12.5.5
Hoya, *Kirchenordnung*, 1571	6/2, pp. 1151, 1186, 1200	2065	four high feasts (Michaelmas for Assumption); feasts wholly kept; apostles until the sermon ends; Latin Mass on four-times feasts	12.5.5, 12.9.3, 12.12.6

Order	Sehling	Doc	Notes	§
Harlingerland, *Kirchenordnung*, 1573/74	7/1, pp. 735–736	2122	as Hoya, in three *Sectiones*	12.5.5, 12.9.2
Oldenburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1573	7/2.1, pp. 1096–1097	2150	Mecklenburg scheme; Michaelmas as four-times feast; Corpus Christi abolished	12.8.9, 12.9.2
Buxtehude, *Kirchenordnung*, 1552	7/1, p. 74	2082	*Gloria* in Latin on high feasts	12.10.1
Buxtehude, *Agende*, 1565	7/1, p. 123	2082	Kyrie grades *in summis festivitatibus* (on the highest festivities), *minus summum* (the lesser summum)	12.4.2
Osnabrück (city), *Kirchenordnung*, 1543	7/1, p. 259	2099	no special holy days; apostles until noon	12.6.1
Osnabrück (city), *Kirchenordnung*, 1613	7/1, p. 267	2100	whole days (two or three sermons); half days (one sermon)	12.6.2
Tecklenburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1543	22, p. 245	1505	Nürnberg list; Assumption kept as four-times feast "for the working folk"; small feasts: no work during the sermon	12.6.2, 12.8.3
Lippe, *Kirchenordnung*, 1571	21, pp. 391–392	1462	Mecklenburg scheme; proper prefaces only on the four-times feasts	12.9.2
Goslar, SS. Simon and Jude, Office, 1534	7/2.2, p. 264	2194	ferial, dominical and festal Office	12.4.4
Bremen, *Kirchenordnung*, 1561	7/2.2, p. 513	2221	thirteen feasts with Latin first vespers	12.4.6
Jülich-Cleves-Berg, visitation instruction, 1559 (Roman Catholic humanist)	21, p. 87	1425	"four high-tide offerings"	12.9.1
Lüneburg, *Artikelbuch*, 1527	6/1, p. 500	1996	fasting free, "to tame the body"	12.13.1
Braunschweig-Wolfenbüttel, *Klosterordnung*, 1569	6/1, p. 307	1978	fish days a monastic house-rule	12.13.1
Lüneburg, *Kirchenordnung der Stadt Lüneburg*, 1575	6/1, p. 672	2017	no weddings in Advent and Lent	12.12.6
Calenberg-Göttingen, *Kirchenordnung*, 1542	6/2, pp. 772, 804	2033, 2036	"who ever taught that Christians should not fast?"; Lenten catechism	12.12.3, 12.13.1
Grubenhagen, *Kirchenordnung*, 1581	6/2, p. 1065	2058	no weddings in Advent, Lent and the high feasts	12.12.6
Oldenburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1573	7/2.1, p. 1081	2149	fasting before the Supper "once or twice in the year"	12.13.2
Oldenburg, visitation articles (Advent and Lent weddings); *Visitationsabschied für Bardenfleth*, 1609	7/2.1, pp. 1180, 1201	2151	Sunday wholly, holy days during the sermon	12.11.1, 12.12.6
Marienhafe (East Frisia), *Kirchenordnung*, 1593	7/1, p. 718	2122	no weddings in Advent and before Easter	12.12.6
Micron, *Christliche Ordinancien* (1554), German edition 1565 (Reformed)	7/1, p. 588	2116	fast day before the election of ministers	12.13.5

Order	Sehling	Doc	Notes	§
Corvey, *Kirchenordnung für das Corveyer Stiftsdorf Bruchhausen*, 1603	21, p. 243	1455	weekly Lenten sermon, two before Easter	12.12.3
Jülich-Kleve, *Kirchenordnung*, 1525 (Roman Catholic humanist)	21, p. 71	1421	fasting exhorted, not commanded	12.13.2

Hesse, the Rhine and the Main

Order	Sehling	Doc	Notes	§
Hessen, Homberg *Reformatio*, 1526 (Moderate Reformed)	8, p. 49	2249	only feasts of the mysteries of redemption, one day each, and the Visitation	12.3.2
Hessen, *Kirchenordnung*, 1532 (Moderate Reformed)	8, p. 75	2252	named saints' days forenoon only	12.3.5
Hessen, *Kirchenordnung*, 1566 (Moderate Reformed)	8, pp. 257–258, 203, 263, 309	2257	feasts of Christ; Christmas "the feast of all feasts"	12.3.6, 12.13.5, 12.13.6
Waldeck, *Landordnung*, 1525	9, p. 179	2300	four high-tide feasts, Marian and apostles' days	12.9.1
Waldeck, *Kirchenordnung*, 1556	9, pp. 272–276	2300	Mecklenburg scheme; Good Friday half; three apostles forenoon; Michaelmas fourth chief feast; three-lesson matins on high feasts	12.4.3, 12.6.1, 12.14.2
Nassau-Dillenburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1537	10, pp. 74, 77	169	wide list incl. Corpus Christi, Assumption, Nativity of Mary; harvest feasts to Sunday	12.5.7, 12.6.4, 12.8.9, 12.13.2
Nassau-Dillenburg (Reformed), *Kirchenordnung*, 1582	10, p. 163	184	Sundays and feasts of Christ only	12.15
Nassau-Weilburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1576, and *Agende*, 1618	10, pp. 228, 239, 310	198	twelve feasts like Sundays; apostles one sermon; 1618: half and whole	12.6.2, 12.11.4, 12.13.5
Nassau-Weilburg, visitation recess, 1609	10, p. 352	199	whole days two sermons; third day, John, Visitation, Michael, apostles half	12.6.2
Ysenburg-Ronneburg, *Agende*, 1582	10, p. 583	218	day by day: whole, half, forenoon; harvest and market	12.6.2
Solms-Laubach, *Kirchenzuchtordnung*, 1603	9, p. 356	2311	whole days; forenoon days; Beheading and Magdalene to weekday sermons	12.6.2, 12.8.8
Sayn, *Kirchenzuchtordnung*, 1582	19/1, pp. 368, 372–373	1090	four classes: chief, middle (half), transferable, abolished	12.5.5
Sayn, *Kirchenordnung*, 1590	19/1, p. 389	1090	one list; harvest apostles forenoon; no transfers	12.6.4, 12.14.4

Order	Sehling	Doc	Notes	§
Wied, *Synodalbeschlüsse*, 1564 (Reformed)	19/1, p. 467	1094	*ferialiter* (whole) and "sermon only"; patronal feasts	12.4.5
Leiningen-Hardenburg (Dürkheim), 1584	19/1, pp. 277–278	1076	high feasts whole day; apostles forenoon	12.6.2
Landau, *Feiertagsordnung*, 1562	19/1, p. 61	1044	high feasts of Christ whole; all others until noon	12.6.2
Pfalz-Zweibrücken, *Feiertagsordnung*, 1561	18, pp. 297–298	973	eight high feasts whole; all others forenoon only	12.6.2
Pfalz-Veldenz, *Kirchenordnung*, 1574	18, pp. 518–519, 520, 560	1011	whole and half days; half days as days of prayer	12.6.2, 12.12.3, 12.13.5
Kurpfalz (Reformed), *Kirchenordnung*, 1563	14, p. 397	504	Christmas, New Year, Easter, Ascension, Whitsun only	12.15
Hesse, *Reformationsordnung*, 1572 (Philippist)	8, p. 401	2272	"heathen" Shrovetide, Walpurgis, Whitsun and St John customs	12.11.4
Nassau-Dillenburg, visitation recesses, 1552 and 1570	10, pp. 95, 115	172, 180	ordinances read at every Ember season	12.12.7
Hanau-Münzenberg, *Reformationsmandat für das Amt Rodheim*, 1596 (Reformed)	10, p. 414	206	fines for Sunday trading and field work	12.11.2
Ysenburg, *Fastnachtsmandate*, 1590 and 1612 (Reformed); police order	10, pp. 593, 693, 707	221, 236, 239	Shrovetide and folk customs forbidden	12.11.4
Solms, *Kirchenordnung*, 1603	9, p. 351	2311	"heathen" folk customs forbidden	12.11.4
Waldeck, *Beschlüsse für die Synode von Mengeringhausen*, 1528; *Niederwildunger Katechismusordnung*, 1533; Shrovetide and *Kirchweih* (church dedication festival) mandates, 1547–1590	9, pp. 185, 191, 222, 297, 299, 301	2300	old fasts kept (1528); Advent catechism; Shrovetide and *Kirchweih* abolished	12.11.4, 12.12.2, 12.13.3
Pfalz-Zweibrücken, *Generalartikel*, 1560	18, p. 293	971	work allowed after the sermon on lesser holy days	12.11.1
Pfalz-Zweibrücken, *Kirchenordnung*, 1557 (with Pfalz-Neuburg 1554)	18, p. 207	967	repentance in Lent; the Passion in Holy Week	12.12.3
Kurpfalz, *Bedenken zur Reformation der Stiftskirchen*, 1546	14, p. 93	471	festal plays and processions abolished	12.10.10
Kurpfalz, *Kirchenordnung*, 1556	14, p. 163	480	repentance in Lent	12.12.3
Kurpfalz, police legislation (Sehling's introduction)	14, p. 66	468	*Kirchweih*, Shrovetide and mummery banned	12.11.4
Kurpfalz, *Mandat zu den Bußtagen*, 1610 (Reformed)	19/2, p. 971	1204	"rightful Christian fasting" not abolished	12.13.5
Baden, mandate of Margrave Philipp, 1531	16, p. 507	702	Lenten, Friday and Saturday abstinence kept	12.13.3

Order	Sehling	Doc	Notes	§
Baden, *Fastnachtsmandat*, 1610	16, p. 572	719	Shrovetide customs forbidden	12.11.4

Upper Germany

Order	Sehling	Doc	Notes	§
Württemberg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1536	16, pp. 105–106	651	high feasts of Christ; other feasts forenoon only	12.3.4, 12.5.3
Württemberg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1553	16, pp. 266, 267	671	holy days proclaimed by the magistrate; one list (two days at the great feasts)	12.3.5, 12.5.3, 12.12.3
Baden, *Kirchenordnungsmandat*, 1603	16, p. 559	715	feasts and apostles forenoon *simpliciter*, field-work after	12.5.3
Schwäbisch Hall, Brenz, *Kirchenordnung*, 1527	17/1, p. 53	755	no holy day commanded by God; a civil list; Stephen and John as one day (B)	12.3.5, 12.7.3
Schwäbisch Hall, Brenz, sermon, 1527	17/1, p. 78	756	feasts a civil ordinance	12.3.5
Esslingen, council decrees, 1537 (Moderate Reformed)	17/2, pp. 389–390	883	all but Sunday and Christmas abolished; apostles' days restored	12.15
Brandenburg-Nürnberg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1533	11, p. 204	270	one list; Assumption kept for the peasants, preached as Visitation	12.8.3
Brandenburg-Ansbach, chapter order, 1533	11, p. 314	276	no saints' octaves or suffrages	12.4.4
Nürnberg, Veit Dietrich, *Agendbüchlein*, 1545	11, p. 538	297	Visitation moved to 15 August	12.6.4
Weißenburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1528	11, p. 662	308	wide list; Stephen and John one day	12.5.7
Hof, *Ordo ecclesiasticus*, 1592	11, pp. 411, 472, 477	294	Kyrie and *Benedicamus* grades; vigils; figural music for the chief feasts	12.4.2, 12.4.6, 12.10.5
Lohr (Rieneck), *Vesperordnung*, 1588	11, p. 699	318	Latin first vespers of high and other feasts	12.4.6
Nördlingen, *Ordnung der ceremonien*, 1544	12, pp. 321–322	373	*Kyrie summum* at Pentecost and Trinity	12.4.2
Augsburg, *Feiertagsordnung*, 1537 (Moderate Reformed)	12, p. 84	339	Sundays, Christmas, Easter, Whitsun, New Year, Ascension, Annunciation only	12.15
Pfalz-Neuburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1543	13, pp. 71, 77–78, 94–95, 96	386	wide list incl. Assumption; others "ungefeiret in gedechtnus" (remembered without being kept holy); Scripture-history feasts break the *lectio continua*	12.3.7, 12.4.3, 12.5.7, 12.10.10
Pfalz-Neuburg, Ottheinrich's order, 1547	14, p. 109	473	prefaces *solemnis* and *dominicalis*	12.10.3
Regensburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1567	13, pp. 474–475	450	feasts of Christ; apostles; John and Michael; communion only on feasts of Christ	12.3.7, 12.5.5, 12.7.1
Brandenburg-Ansbach-Kulmbach, *Landtagsabschied*, 1526	11, pp. 92–93	259	fasting exhorted, not commanded	12.13, 12.13.2

Order	Sehling	Doc	Notes	§
Schweinfurt, *Kirchenordnung*, 1543	11, p. 646	304	"Wir glauben" (We believe) for "Nun bitten" (Now pray we the Holy Ghost) in Advent	12.10.11
Thüngen, *Kirchenordnung*, 1564	11, p. 737	326	Corpus Christi and the *Hagelfeier* (hail holiday) condemned	12.11.4
Pfalz-Neuburg, edict, 1555	13, p. 115	395	edicts read at the Ember times	12.12.7
Kurpfalz (Upper Palatinate), *Visitationsordnung*, 1579	13, p. 316	416	weddings suspended in Advent and Lent	12.12.6
Regensburg, *Kirchenregimentsordnung*, 1572	13, p. 509	452	Easter communion of the young	12.12.3
Hohenlohe, *Kirchenordnung*, 1553	15, p. 77	539	festal plays and processions abolished	12.10.10
Württemberg, *Klosterordnung*, 1535	16, p. 79	647	monastic fasts among human ordinances	12.13.6
Schwäbisch Hall, *Kirchenordnung*, 1543	17/1, p. 155	762	no weddings at the high feasts, in Advent and Lent	12.12.6

Alsace

Order	Sehling	Doc	Notes	§
Mülhausen, council decree, 1524 (Reformed)	20/2, p. 196	1377	four high-tides, Marian and apostles' days; lesser days abolished	12.15
Mülhausen, opinion on the Basel order, 1529 (Reformed)	20/2, pp. 214–215	1382	Sundays, Christmas, Ascension, Easter, Whitsun only	12.15
Strasbourg, synodal decrees, 1544 (Moderate Reformed)	20/1, pp. 342–343	1312	only Sunday in the city; countryside half and whole days	12.15
Strasbourg, *Mandat zur Sonntagsheiligung*, 1534 (Moderate Reformed)	20/1, p. 246	1296	Sunday work fined; fish sold in Lent	12.11.2, 12.13.4
Strasbourg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1598	20/1, p. 636	1344	closed seasons for weddings	12.12.6
Colmar (Sehling's introduction; before the city's Reformation of 1575)	20/2, p. 481	1407	complaint of lax Lenten fasting, 1560	12.13.3

Transylvania

Order	Sehling	Doc	Notes	§
Honterus, *Reformationsbüchlein*, 1543	24, p. 189	1666	feasts kept for their Scripture histories	12.3.7
Transylvanian Saxons, *Kirchenordnung*, 1547	24, p. 222	1669	fuller matins and Latin *Te Deum* (We praise thee, O God) on greater feasts	12.4.3
Burzenland chapter, 1573	24, p. 371	1694	Annunciation moved to Maundy Thursday that year	12.14.2
Kosd and Schelken, statutes, 1577	24, p. 400	1704	only feasts with Scripture history; no transfers	12.3.7, 12.14.4
Mediasch synod, 1578	24, pp. 427–428	1707	apostles' days *intercise*; feasts of Christ *totaliter*	12.6.4

Order	Sehling	Doc	Notes	§
Burzenland, *Visitationsartikel*, 1578	24, p. 452	1710	weekday feasts only until noon	12.6.4

Chapter 13. Extraordinary Rites

This chapter covers the occasional and extraordinary rites of the church in the evangelical church orders of the sixteenth century, as printed in Emil Sehling's *Die evangelischen Kirchenordnungen des XVI. Jahrhunderts* (The Evangelical Church Orders of the Sixteenth Century). It asks, for each rite:

- **Was it kept, recast or abolished?** Which medieval sacraments, consecrations and blessings survived in an evangelical form, and on what grounds were the others given up?
- **What was the full liturgy?** Where an order prints a form, what is its order of service, and what are its formulas, vows and prayers?
- **How did the orders differ?** How do the Lutheran, Upper German and Reformed forms compare, and which orders copied which?
- **Who performed it, and where?** The pastor, the superintendent, the consistory, the elders or the congregation; in the church, at the font, at the altar, in the house or at the grave.

How the chapter is laid out.

- §13.1 summarizes the findings, and §13.2 sets out the scope, sources and method.
- §§13.3–13.9 deal with the sacramental acts and the rites of life and death:
  - §13.3, baptism;
  - §13.4, exorcism;
  - §13.5, churching;
  - §13.6, confirmation;
  - §13.7, marriage, with betrothal, its dissolution, divorce and annulment;
  - §13.8, the sick (including extreme unction), the dying, the condemned and the possessed;
  - §13.9, funerals and burial.
- §§13.10–13.13 deal with offices:
  - §13.10, ordination;
  - §13.11, installation of pastors, superintendents, abbots and bishops;
  - §13.12, minor orders, lay offices, church workers, and the religious (sick-women, nuns, convent heads, monks and novices);
  - §13.13, magistrates and civil offices.
- §13.14 covers the dedication of churches and the *Kirchweih* (church dedication festival), and §13.15 the blessings of objects and their abolition.
- §13.16 covers the ban, excommunication, public penance and the restoration of the penitent, and §13.17 private confession and absolution.
- §13.18 covers processions, and §13.19 the tonsure, the return of churches and vessels to common use, and the deposition of ministers.
- §13.20 covers sorcery and the cleansing of houses, churches and things.
- §13.21 covers the Litany, the suffrages and the Good Friday solemn prayers at the Mass and in the services that stood in for it.
- §13.22 covers other occasional rites, chiefly the parish visitation.
- §13.23 covers the rites of particular feasts and seasons: Christmas, Candlemas, Ash Wednesday, Palm Sunday, Holy Week, Easter, Ascension, Whitsun, Septuagesima and Trinity.
- §13.24 is a table by order, and §13.25 a concordance of every order quoted.

Each topic is supported by quotations in the original language (Early New High German, Low German or Latin), each followed by an English translation.

13.1 Summary of findings

13.1.1 The main findings

1. The sacraments: one rite kept whole, the rest reduced to Word and prayer. Baptism was the rite the orders printed most often and most fully (§13.3). Of the other medieval sacraments, none survived as a sacrament, but all left an evangelical rite in

their place:

- **Confirmation** became a catechetical examination with prayer and, in many orders, the laying on of hands (§13.6).
- **Marriage** became a "worldly business" blessed by the church (§13.7).
- **Ordination** became a call, examination, prayer and the laying on of hands (§13.10).
- **Penance** became private confession and absolution, without enumeration of sins (§13.17), and, for open sinners, public penance and absolution (§13.16).
- **Extreme unction** was abolished as without command; the orders read James 5 as the elders' prayer and replaced the oil with the Word, absolution and communion of the sick (§13.8.1).

2. Baptism fell into four families (§13.3):

- the received rite in German (Luther 1523, Nuremberg and Strasbourg 1524 (Moderate Reformed), Ansbach 1526, Brandenburg 1540);
- Luther's revised *Taufbüchlein* (baptism booklet) of 1526, the Lutheran standard;
- the Upper German rite of Strasbourg (Moderate Reformed) and Württemberg (Lutheran), without exorcism or cross;
- the Reformed rite of the Palatinate and the stranger churches, which forbade emergency baptism by women.

Salt, spittle, oil, the candle and the font blessing went almost everywhere. The chrism was kept only in Electoral Brandenburg 1540 and Pfalz-Neuburg 1543 (§§13.3.2, 13.15.4).

3. Exorcism became the confessional marker (§13.4). The Lutheran orders kept Luther's shortened exorcism, glossed as a prayer and confession of original sin. The Upper German orders never had it after the 1520s. From the 1560s the Philippist and Reformed territories abolished it by mandate, and some Lutheran ones tolerated or softened it.

4. No chrismation, no consecrations, no blessings of things. No order:

- anoints at confirmation (§13.6);
- consecrates a bishop with a separate rite (§13.11.4);
- consecrates a church, altar or churchyard (§13.14);
- blesses water, salt, candles, ashes, palms, fire, the font, *Fladen* (flat cakes), herbs, wine or bells (§13.15).

The abolition lists run in nearly the same words from 1524 to the 1590s. Their grounds are that creatures are sanctified by God's word and by thanksgiving, that no command or promise of God stands behind the blessing, and that the blessed objects had become means of superstition.

5. Churching survived in some places as thanksgiving (§13.5). Many orders abolished the "leading in" of the mother after childbirth. Others kept her first churchgoing as a thanksgiving with prayer, and a few printed a form.

6. The rites of the sick replaced unction with Word and Sacrament (§13.8). The reserved sacrament and its procession were abolished, and communion was given in the house. Only the Ansbach diet of 1526 still kept leftovers in the sacrament house; the later orders count the communicants and have the minister or communicants consume what remains (§§13.22.3, 13.22.5). No order keeps the Mass of the Presanctified: on Good Friday there was a full communion or none (§13.22.4). Forms were written for the dying, the plague-stricken and the condemned. Pomerania 1569 gave a rite of prayer over the possessed in place of exorcism.

7. Funerals became a testimony of faith (§13.9). Vigils, soul-Masses and the Masses of the seventh and thirtieth day were abolished. Burial with procession, hymns, bells and, later, a sermon was kept as the church's witness to the resurrection, and it could therefore be refused to the impenitent and the excommunicate.

8. Ordination was kept, mostly on the Wittenberg pattern (§13.10). The Wittenberg pattern was a public call, examination, prayer, laying on of hands by the ministers and a charge. In Saxony it was given centrally at Wittenberg or Leipzig; in Hesse, Lippe and many later orders it was given in the candidate's own parish, joined to his installation. The vesting, the anointing of the hands and the delivery of chalice and paten were dropped. Installation (*Investitur*) of a pastor in his parish was a separate rite, led by the superintendent (§13.11).

9. Lay offices were filled by oath, pledge or election, not by rite (§13.12). Laying on of hands for elders and deacons is found only in Hesse 1566 (Moderate Reformed), the London church and the Palatinate 1592 (both Reformed). Sextons, schoolmasters, churchwardens and midwives were bound by pledge or oath. The sexton was also the sacristan; no order has a separate sacristan

or an altar guild. No order ordains or blesses a deaconess. Sick-women and beguines who nursed the sick were appointed by the council and examined or instructed by the pastor.

10. Nuns were received with an evangelical rite; monks were not (§§13.12.7–13.12.10). Keppel 1570 prints the one evangelical clothing of a nun. It consists of questions to parents, *domina* and candidate, an oath with the hand on the breast, a sermon, the clothing in the sacristy, *Veni Sancte Spiritus* (Come, Holy Spirit), an exhortation that the vows earn nothing and the convent is "no prison" but a school, and the *Te Deum* (We praise thee, O God). Abbesses, prioresses and *dominae* were elected and swore oaths of office. No order admits a monk by profession: monasteries kept as schools received novices as scholars without vows. Brunswick-Wolfenbüttel 1569 supplies the words with which a sister laid aside her cowl and crown, since baptism is the true clothing.

11. Magistrates had no rite (§13.13). The orders give the council-election sermon, the intercession for the magistrate and the clergy's place in the oath of homage, but no coronation or installation.

12. The ban was rebuilt on Matthew 18 (§13.16). The lesser ban (exclusion from the Sacrament) was distinguished from the greater ban (public exclusion and "delivering to Satan"). The Lutheran territories gave the decision to the consistory. Wittenberg 1542, Mecklenburg 1570, Mansfeld 1580 and Saxe-Lauenburg 1585 print full forms of excommunication, public penance and absolution. The Reformed gave the decision to the congregation through its elders; Micron's London order prints a full liturgy of excision and readmission.

13. Betrothal and divorce came under the church's eye (§§13.7.8–13.7.10). Secret betrothals were made void; the pastor examined the betrothed before the banns (at Wertheim he presided at the betrothal itself); only the consistory could release a betrothed person or declare a spouse free after adultery or desertion; annulment was a declaration that no marriage had existed; and the innocent party's remarriage was quiet, without banns or pomp.

14. The marks of the sacred state were dropped without rites of their own (§§13.18–13.19). The processions with the sacrament, relics and holy water went, except in Electoral Brandenburg, which kept the Sunday, Palm Sunday and Rogation processions in a purified form. The processions that remained were led by a cross carried by a schoolboy or the sexton, then the singing schoolboys, then the clergy in surplices, then the people. No order puts a bishop, a deacon or any minor order in a procession, or has a thurible, torches, banner, canopy, crosier or Gospel book carried (§13.18.4). The tonsure was abolished and forbidden to the remaining old-believing clergy. Churches, altars and vessels were cleared out by authority and their goods turned to the common chest, without a rite of deconsecration. Unworthy ministers were deposed by a sentence read to the congregation, not degraded.

15. Sorcery: no rite of cleansing (§13.20). No order exorcizes, sprinkles or reconsecrates a house, a church or a thing that sorcery or the devil had touched. The holy water, salt, herbs and candles of the old cleansing were themselves called sorcery and "the devil's doctrines" (Braunschweig 1528). What the orders prescribe instead:

- **Prayer.** Mecklenburg 1540 and Pomerania 1542 bless the sick man's house with a prayer that God drive out "all spooks, ghosts and power of the devil".
- **Burning.** The tools of sorcery were burned in public: the charms, the written blessings, the blessed and bewitched things and the sorcerers' books (Württemberg 1552, Hohenlohe 1558 and 1588, Castell 1579). Worshipped images were broken and burned (Mecklenburg 1552, Sponheim 1566).
- **Guarding.** The baptismal water was poured away at once, so that no sorcerer could have it.
- **Repentance.** Those who had sought out charmers asked pardon before the congregation and were absolved, or were kept from the Supper.

16. The Litany replaced the Mass without communicants, and the solemn prayers survived once (§13.21). Luther's German and Latin Litanies, without the saints, were sung:

- in place of the Supper when no one communed (Mecklenburg 1552, Pfalz-Neuburg 1543, Grubenhagen 1544, which calls it the old "prayer-Mass");
- between epistle and gospel, during a long communion, or after the sermon, by boys kneeling before the altar or by the pastor from the pulpit;
- on Wednesdays and Fridays, in Rogation week and at the Ember seasons.

Zweibrücken (1533) and Pfalz-Veldenz (1574) tied it to the Christmas, Easter and Whitsun weeks, and Schwäbisch Hall (1543) and Limpurg (1610) to Good Friday. Only Waldeck (1556) prints the Good Friday solemn prayers: eleven German biddings, each with a collect, without *Flectamus genua*, the pope or the pagans, and with new prayers for persecutors, false Christians and enemies. No order has a Litany at the Easter Vigil.

17. The rites of the feasts were reduced to their history (§13.23). No order keeps the *Exsultet*, the new fire, the paschal candle, the ashes or the Christmas Kalenda. Electoral Brandenburg 1540 alone kept the Palm Sunday procession, the Maundy Thursday foot-washing and the representations of Christ's burial and resurrection. Christmas and Easter Matins were moved from midnight to the morning, and the Good Friday solemn prayers survived at Mülhausen (Reformed) and Waldeck. No order buries the Alleluia at Septuagesima ("the Alleluia is the perpetual voice of the church", Luther), but several make the Athanasian Creed the text of Trinity Sunday.

13.1.2 Where the full liturgies are

The forms printed in full or quoted at length in this chapter are:

Rite	Principal full forms (§)
Baptism	Luther 1523 and 1526 (3.2–3.3); the anointings of Brandenburg 1540 and Pfalz-Neuburg 1543 (13.3.2); Saxony 1539 (13.3.4); Württemberg 1536/1553 and Strasbourg 1537 (Moderate Reformed) (13.3.5); Palatinate 1563 (Reformed) (13.3.6)
Emergency baptism and its confirmation	Saxony 1539 (13.3.7)
Exorcism	Luther 1526 (13.3.3); its glosses and abolitions (13.4)
Churching	Mansfeld 1580 (13.5.2)
Confirmation	Ziegenhain 1539 (Moderate Reformed) (13.6.2); Calenberg-Göttingen 1542 (13.6.3); Brandenburg 1540 (13.6.4); Mansfeld 1580 (13.6.5)
Marriage	Luther 1529 (13.7.1); Brandenburg-Nürnberg 1533 (13.7.2); Strasbourg 1537 (Moderate Reformed) (13.7.3)
Sick and dying	Saxony 1539 (13.8.3); Dietrich 1545 (13.8.4, 13.8.6); Pomerania 1569 (13.8.7)
Burial	Saxony 1539/1540 (13.9.2); Brandenburg-Nürnberg 1533 (13.9.3)
Ordination	Luther 1537–1539 (13.10.2); Merseburg 1545 (13.10.3); Regensburg 1553 (13.10.4); Hesse 1574 (Philippist) and the Palatinate 1592 (Reformed) (13.10.5)
Installation	Saxony 1580 and Wolfenbüttel 1569 (13.11.1); the Palatinate 1592 (Reformed) (13.11.2); Württemberg prelates (13.11.3)
Elders and deacons	Hesse 1566 (Moderate Reformed), Micron 1554 and the Palatinate 1592 (Reformed) (13.12.1)
Deaconesses and sick-women	Nördlingen 1544, Heilbronn 1531 (13.12.6)
Clothing of a nun	Keppel 1570 (13.12.7)
Convent heads	Keppel 1570, Schleswig-Holstein after 1610 (13.12.8)
Novices and monks	Ravengiersburg 1560 (13.12.9); Württemberg prelates (13.11.3)
Laying aside the habit	Brunswick-Wolfenbüttel 1569 (13.12.10)
Sextons, schoolmasters, organists, churchwardens, stewards	oaths and pledges: Lippe 1571, Heidelberg 1572 (Reformed), Anhalt 1594 (Philippist) (13.12.2); Mulhouse 1551 (Reformed), the Palatinate 1580, Gengenbach 1536 (Moderate Reformed), Hildesheim 1581 (13.12.3); Leisnig 1529, Saxe-Lauenburg 1585, the Palatinate 1577 (Reformed), Strasbourg 1523 (Moderate Reformed) (13.12.4)

Rite	Principal full forms (§)
Church dedication	Hof: the dedication of 1572, its yearly festival, and the school dedication of 1546 (13.14.3)
Betrothal, divorce, remarriage	Wertheim 1530 (13.7.8); Prussia 1575 (13.7.9); Saxony 1556, the Palatinate 1563 (Reformed), Brandenburg 1573 (13.7.10)
Excommunication, public penance, absolution	Wittenberg 1542 (13.16.2); Saxe-Lauenburg 1585 (13.16.3); Mecklenburg 1570 (13.16.4); Mansfeld 1580 (13.16.5); Grubenhagen 1581 (13.16.6); Micron 1554 (13.16.7)
Private confession and absolution	the catechism form, Palatinate 1556; Brandenburg 1540 (17.2–17.3)
Processions	Brandenburg 1540 (13.18.2); order of march and objects carried: Stendal 1541, Brandenburg 1540, Waldeck 1556, Havelberg 1558, Hof 1592, Strasbourg 1598 (13.18.4)
Deposition of a minister	Hesse 1566 (Moderate Reformed) (13.19.3)
Blessing of a house against the devil	Mecklenburg 1540/1545, Pomerania 1542 (13.20.2)
Litany in place of the Mass; Good Friday solemn prayers	Pfalz-Neuburg 1543, Mecklenburg 1552, Grubenhagen 1544, Hof 1592 (13.21.1); Waldeck 1556 (13.21.2, 13.21.6); Pomerania 1569 (13.21.4)
Visitation	Pfalz-Neuburg 1560 (13.22.1)

13.2 Scope, sources and method

13.2.1 The corpus and the rites covered

The corpus. The corpus is Sehling's edition, volumes 1–24, as held in `eko.db`. This chapter quotes the sixteenth- and early seventeenth-century texts; the editors' introductions and notes are cited as such where they matter.

The rites covered. "Extraordinary" here means every rite outside the ordinary Sunday and weekday services, what German liturgics calls the *Kasualien* and the episcopal acts. The chapter covers:

- the sacramental acts: baptism, exorcism, confirmation, marriage (with betrothal, its dissolution, divorce and annulment), private confession and absolution, extreme unction;
- the rites of passage around birth, sickness and death: churching, the visitation of the sick, funerals and burial;
- the acts of the ministry: ordination, installation of pastors and prelates, the consecration of bishops;
- the lay offices: elders, deacons, sextons, schoolmasters, cantors, churchwardens, midwives;
- civil offices: magistrates and oaths of homage;
- consecrations and blessings: churches, churchyards, altars, chrism, water, candles, palms, bells, wreaths;
- discipline: the lesser and greater ban, excommunication, public penance and the restoration of the penitent, the deposition of ministers;
- marks of the clerical and sacred state: the tonsure, the deconsecration of churches and vessels;
- processions;
- what was done with houses, churches and things that sorcery or the devil had touched;
- other occasional services, such as the parish visitation.

Full liturgies and summaries. Where an order prints a full rite, the chapter gives its order of service step by step and quotes its central texts: the formula of baptism, the vows, the prayers, the formula at the laying on of hands, the sentence of excommunication. Where many orders repeat one form, the chapter quotes the principal witness and lists the others. Where an order only mentions or abolishes a rite, the chapter summarizes it with a citation.

13.2.2 How the corpus was searched

Every document was scanned with regular expressions for the groups of terms below. Matches were read in context, and then the full passages were pulled from the relevant orders.

- **Baptism and exorcism.** *Tauf* (baptism), *Taufbüchlein* (baptism booklet), *Nottaufe* (emergency baptism), *Gevatter* (godparent), *Pate* (godparent), *exorcismus* (exorcism), *beschweren* (adjure), *Westerhemd* (christening robe), *Chresem*, *Chrisam* (chrism), *Salz* (salt), *Speichel* (spittle), *Juden* (Jews).
- **Churching and confirmation.** *Sechswöchnerin* (woman in childbed), *Kindbetterin* (woman in childbed), *einleiten* (lead in), *einsegnen* (bless), *aussegnen* (bless out), *Kirchgang* (churching); *Firmung*, *Confirmation* (confirmation), *Handauflegung* (laying on of hands), *Katechismusverhör* (catechism examination).
- **Marriage.** *Trauung*, *zusammengeben*, *copuliren*, *Brautmesse* (bridal Mass), *Aufgebot* (banns), *proclamiren* (proclaim), *Kranz* (wreath), *Kirchgang*, *Witwe* (widow).
- **The sick and the dead.** *Kranke* (the sick), *Ölung* (anointing), *Sterbende* (the dying), *Pest* (plague), *Gefangene* (prisoners), *zum Tode verurteilt* (condemned to death), *Besessene* (the possessed); *Begräbnis* (burial), *Leiche* (corpse), *Leichpredigt* (funeral sermon), *Vigilien* (vigils), *Seelmesse* (requiem Mass), *Begängnis* (obsequies), *Kirchhof* (churchyard), *Gottesacker* (God's acre).
- **Ministry.** *Ordination*, *ordiniren* (ordain), *Priesterweihe* (priestly consecration), *Investitur* (investiture), *einweisen* (induct), *installiren* (install), *praesentiren* (present), *Superintendent*, *Bischof* (bishop), *Prälat* (prelate); *Küster* (sexton), *Mesner* (sexton), *Opfermann* (sexton), *Schulmeister* (schoolmaster), *Kantor* (cantor), *Organist*, *Kirchvater* (churchwarden), *Kastenherr* (chest-warden), *Hebamme* (midwife); *Senioren* (seniors), *Älteste* (elders), *Diakon* (deacon).
- **Magistrates.** *Obrigkeit* (magistracy), *Ratswahl* (council election), *Ratspredigt* (council sermon), *Huldigung* (homage), *Erbhuldigung* (hereditary homage).
- **Consecrations and blessings.** *Einweihung* (consecration), *Kirchweih* (church dedication festival), *Kirmes* (parish fair), *Kirchmesse* (parish fair), *Kirbe* (parish fair), *dedicatio* (dedication), *consecratio* (consecration); *weihen* (hallow) and *segnen* (bless) with *Wasser* (water), *Salz*, *Kerzen* (candles), *Licht* (light), *Palmen* (palms), *Kräuter* (herbs), *Wurz* (herbs), *Feuer* (fire), *Fladen* (flat cakes), *Eier* (eggs), *Wein* (wine), *Johannissegen* (St John's blessing); *Glocken* (bells), *Glockentaufe* (baptism of bells), *Wetterläuten* (ringing against storms).
- **Betrothal, divorce, confession, unction.** *Verlöbnis* (betrothal), *Ehegelübde* (marriage vow), *Eheversprechen* (promise of marriage), *sponsalia* (betrothal), *Handschlag*, *Weinkauf* (betrothal drink), *ledig sprechen* (declare free), *Ehescheidung*, *divortium* (divorce), *Scheidebrief* (bill of divorce), *impotentia* (impotence); *Beicht* (confession), *Ohrenbeicht*, *Privatabsolution*, *Beichtgeld*; *Ölung*, *olye*, *unctio*, James 5.
- **Tonsure, profanation, deposition, processions.** *Platte*, *Tonsur* (tonsure), *Krone scheren* (shave the crown); *profan* (profane), *abbrechen* (pull down) with *Altar* and *Kapelle* (chapel), *Kelch* (chalice) and *Ornat* (ornaments) with *verkaufen* (sell); *entsetzen* (depose), *absetzen* (depose), *degradieren* (degrade); *Procession*, *Kreuzgang* (procession with the cross), *Umgang* (procession), *circuitus* (circuit).
- **Discipline.** *Bann* (ban), *kleiner* (lesser) and *großer Bann* (greater ban), *excommunicatio* (excommunication), *dem Satan übergeben* (deliver to Satan), *ausschließen* (exclude), *abschneiden* (cut off), *öffentliche Buße* (public penance), *Kirchenbuße* (church penance), *Absolution*, *wieder aufnehmen* (receive again), *reconciliatio* (reconciliation).
- **Sorcery and cleansing.** *Zauberei* (sorcery), *töverie* (sorcery), *Hexe* (witch), *Unhold* (witch), *Segner* (charmer), *Segensprecher* (charmer), *Wahrsager* (soothsayer), *Christallseher* (crystal-gazer), *Teufelsbeschwerer* (devil-conjurer), *Gespenst* (ghost), *Poltergeist*, *spökenisse* (spooks); *verbrennen* (burn), *zerbrechen* (break), *reinigen* (cleanse), *reconciliatio*, *exorcismus salis* (exorcism of salt); *Taufwasser* (baptismal water), *Hostien* (hosts) and *Altartuch* (altar cloth) with *Zauberei*; *Haus* (house) with *segnen* and *beschweren*.

Related chapters.

- Chapter 16 covers the minor orders, the diaconate, the eldership, sacristans, deaconesses and the religious, with the installation of each office (§13.12 here summarizes it).
- Chapter 17 covers the oaths and vows taken at ordination, installation and confirmation.
- Chapter 12 covers the closed seasons for weddings, the prayer and fast days, and the *Kirchweih* as a holiday.
- Chapter 6 covers the intercessions for magistrates, the sick and the dying.
- Chapter 11 covers wedding and funeral sermons.
- Chapter 8 covers the hymns sung at baptism, weddings and burials.
- Chapter 15 covers catechesis before confirmation and marriage, and the duties of the officers installed here (§§15.3–15.11).
- Chapter 14 covers the font, lights and vestments, and the image plays of the feasts (§§14.4.6, 14.5.6, 14.7).
- Chapter 9 covers bells for the dead and at baptisms and weddings (§§9.5.6–9.5.7).
- Chapter 3 covers general confession at the Mass and its relation to private confession (§3.4.6).
- Chapter 10 covers the Litany at the hours (§10.7.5).

13.2.3 Cautions

- **Record headings and dates in the database.** A database record often holds more than one order, and its year field can be wrong. In this chapter every order is named from the running head of the page on which the quotation stands. Some examples:
  - The Henneberg record dated 1555 holds the *Kirchenordnung* (church order) of Georg Ernst of 1582 and a consistory report of 1635.
  - The record for Müntzer's Allstedt text (Radical Reformation) is filed with the Saxon visitation of 1533.
  - The Grubenhagen order of 1581 is dated "1506" in the database.
  - The Solms record dated 1603 holds the discipline orders of 1582, 1584 and 1594.
  - The Danzig church order of 1612 stands in a record headed with the Danzig order of 1557.
  - The Schwäbisch Hall *Kirchenordnung* of 1543/1615 is split across records whose headings are taken from stray lines of the text ("Psalm or a penitential psalm …", dated 1614).
- **Summaries by the editor.** Some rites survive only in Sehling's summary of a manuscript, such as the Merseburg ordination draft of 1545 (§13.10.3). These are marked as the editor's.
- **What the orders do not print.** The orders print what the church controlled. Civil oaths, coronations and the installation of magistrates were matters for the territorial and town constitutions and are mostly absent (§13.13). A missing rite is not proof that nothing was done.

13.3 Baptism

The orders print more baptismal forms than forms for any other rite. They fall into four families, and nearly every form in the corpus can be placed in one of them:

- **The received rite in German.** These are translations of the Latin *ordo baptismi* (order of baptism) with nearly all its ceremonies: Luther's *Taufbüchlein* (baptism booklet) of 1523, Nuremberg 1524, the Strasbourg German baptism of 1524 (Moderate Reformed) and the Ansbach "Würzburg rubrics" of 1526. Electoral Brandenburg in 1540 kept most of these ceremonies.
- **Luther's revised *Taufbüchlein* of 1526.** This keeps the exorcism, the sign of the cross, the Flood prayer, the Gospel of the children, the renunciation and the threefold creed. It drops salt, spittle, oil, chrism and candle. It was taken into most Lutheran orders, often with an exhortation added before it and an address to the godparents after it.
- **The Upper German rite.** This is Strasbourg after 1525 (Moderate Reformed), Württemberg in 1536 and 1553 (Lutheran) and their many dependants. It has no exorcism and no sign of the cross. It is built from teaching, prayer, the Gospel and the creed, and the child is baptized by pouring.
- **The Reformed rite.** This is the Palatinate in 1563, the London strangers' church and the Lower Rhine. It is a covenant exhortation, a recast Flood prayer, the Lord's Prayer and the creed, a question to the parents, pouring and a thanksgiving. Emergency baptism by women is forbidden.

Exorcism, the point on which the families divided most sharply, is treated on its own in §13.4.

13.3.1 What God instituted and what men added

The orders sort the ceremonies of baptism by one test: what Christ commanded, and what was added by human beings. What was added is then judged by whether it is free, useful or superstitious. Brandenburg-Nürnberg in 1533 states the test most clearly. Prayer, the Gospel and godparents are kept. The blessing of the font, oil, salt and spittle are dropped. **Brandenburg-Nürnberg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1533** (Sehling 11, p. 174):

Now God hath Himself instituted and ordained baptism, that one shall baptize with water in the name of the Father and of the Son and of the Holy Ghost. To this men have added of their own motion prayer, gospel, godparents, chrisom-robe, the blessing of the font, oil, salt and spittle, etc. […] Now that prayer be spoken withal, and the holy gospel read, is not only free, but also profitable and good. Therefore shall it be let remain. Likewise also the godparents […] But the blessing of the font, oil, salt and spittle darken rather the essential parts of baptism; for they further and serve only superstition.

Luther had made the same distinction in the epilogue to the *Taufbüchlein* (baptism booklet), printed with both versions. The outward ceremonies are "the least" part of baptism. What matters is that the godparents stand in faith, hear the Word and pray

in earnest. **Luther, *Das taufbuchlin verdeutscht*, 1523, epilogue** (Sehling 1, p. 20):

So consider now, that in baptizing these outward pieces are the least, as namely to breathe under the eyes, to sign with crosses, to put salt in the mouth, to put spittle and clay in the ears and nose, to anoint with oil on the breast and shoulders, and to smear the crown with chrism, to put on the chrisom-robe, and to give burning candles in the hand, and whatsoever more there is that hath been added by men to adorn baptism. For baptism may well be done without all such, and they are not the right grips that the devil feareth or fleeth.

13.3.2 The received rite: Luther's *Taufbüchlein* of 1523

Luther's first German baptismal book translated the Wittenberg form of the Latin rite almost whole. Its order can stand for all the early German translations. Nuremberg in 1524, Strasbourg in 1524 (Moderate Reformed) and Ansbach in 1526 differ from it only in detail. Sehling 1, pp. 18–20:

1. **Exsufflation and first exorcism.** The minister breathes three times under the child's eyes: "Depart, thou unclean spirit, and give place to the Holy Ghost".
2. **Sign of the cross** on forehead and breast.
3. **Two prayers.** The first is "O almighty everlasting God … look upon this N.". The second is "O God, the immortal comfort of all that ask aught".
4. **Salt** is put in the mouth: "Take, N., the salt of wisdom".
5. **The Flood prayer** (*Sintflutgebet*), Luther's own composition (quoted in full in §13.3.3).
6. **Two exorcisms.** The first is "Therefore, thou wretched devil, acknowledge thy sentence". The second is "I adjure thee, thou unclean spirit".
7. **A prayer for enlightenment**: "O Lord, holy Father, almighty everlasting God, from whom cometh all light of truth".
8. **The Gospel of the children**, Mark 10:13–16, with the greeting.
9. **The Lord's Prayer**, the priest laying his hands on the child's head and kneeling with the godparents.
10. **The *Ephphatha*.** Spittle is touched to the ears and nose, the child is led into the church, and the minister says "The Lord preserve thy going in and thy coming out".
11. **Renunciation and creed.** The threefold renunciation, then the threefold creed in question and answer.
12. **Anointing** with oil on the breast and between the shoulders.
13. **The question and the baptism.** "Wilt thou be baptized?", then immersion in the font with the Trinitarian formula.
14. **Chrism** on the crown, with the blessing "The almighty God and Father of our Lord Jesus Christ, who hath begotten thee again".
15. **The white robe and the candle.** The hood or chrisom-robe is put on, and a burning candle is given into the hand.

The ceremonies after the Gospel, which Luther dropped three years later, read as follows. **Luther, *Das taufbuchlin verdeutscht*, 1523** (Sehling 1, pp. 19–20):

Then let him take spittle with the finger and touch therewith the right ear and say: *Ephphatha*, that is, Be thou opened. To the nose and to the left ear: But thou, devil, flee, for God's judgement cometh near. […] Then let him anoint the child with holy oil on the breast and between the shoulders and say: And I anoint thee with saving oil in Jesus Christ our Lord. And let him ask: Wilt thou be baptized? Answer: Yes. Then let him take the child and dip it in the font, and say: And I baptize thee in the name of the Father and of the Son and of the Holy Ghost. Then shall the godparents hold the child in the font, and the priest make it a cross with the oil on the crown […] Take the white, holy and undefiled garment, which thou shalt bring without spot before the judgement seat of Christ, that thou mayest have eternal life. Peace be with thee. Then let it be lifted out of the font, and the priest give it a candle in the hand: Take this burning torch and keep thy baptism blameless, that when the Lord cometh to the wedding thou mayest go to meet him, together with the saints, into the heavenly hall, and have eternal life. Amen.

The other early translations kept still more. The Strasbourg German baptism of 1524 (Moderate Reformed) prints the blessing of the salt with its own exorcism, and four exorcisms of the child where Luther has two. **Strasbourg, the early agendas: the German baptism, 1524** (Moderate Reformed; Sehling 20/1, p. 124):

Hereafter the salt is blessed with the following words: I adjure thee, creature of salt, in the name of God [+], the almighty Father, and in the love of our Lord Jesus Christ [+] and in the power of the Holy Ghost [+].

Brandenburg 1540: salt and chrism kept. Electoral Brandenburg is the one territorial order that kept the old ceremonies on principle. Its baptism has the long prayers of 1523, the salt and the chrism, with a careful explanation. The chrism signifies the

royal priesthood of Christians. It is not "of the substance" of baptism, and a child baptized in an emergency is not to be chrismed afterwards, lest the chrism seem necessary. **Brandenburg (Electorate), *Kirchenordnung* of Joachim II, 1540** (Sehling 3, p. 54):

And because there is in particular an old received ceremony, to use the chrism at baptism, we will let the same still remain in use, but yet the meaning of it shall be in the understanding following. […] but therewithal the people shall nevertheless be sufficiently taught that only the Holy Ghost anointeth us in baptism and maketh us Christians, and not the chrism, which is only a signification of it; that those also who are not anointed with chrism are none the less perfect Christians, and it is no hurt to them at all; therefore also [it is] needless to chrism afterwards the children that have been baptized in haste and need by women or otherwise, for so it would be regarded as necessary.

The anointings in the Brandenburg rite. The Brandenburg baptism has both medieval anointings. After the renunciation and the threefold creed the priest anoints the child with the oil of catechumens on the breast and between the shoulders. After the baptism and the prayer "The almighty God" he anoints the crown of the head with chrism in the form of a cross, while the godparents take their hands away. The white cap (*Westerhäublein*) and the burning candle follow. **Brandenburg (Electorate), *Kirchenordnung* of Joachim II, 1540** (Sehling 3, pp. 58–59):

Thereupon the priest anointeth the child on the breast and between the shoulders with the oil of catechumens, and saith: So I anoint thee with the oil of gladness in Christ † Jesus. And straightway the priest taketh the child in his hands, holdeth it over the font, anointeth it between the shoulders, and saith: Our Lord. Soon thereafter he asketh what the child is called, and saith: N., wilt thou be baptized? Answer: Yea, I will. Then he taketh the child again and saith: And I baptize thee in the name of the Father and of the Son and of the Holy Ghost. Thereafter the godparents come near and hold the child over the font, and the priest saith: Let us pray. The almighty God and Father of our Lord Jesus Christ, who hath begotten thee again by water and the Holy Ghost, and hath forgiven thee all thy sins — Then the priest anointeth the baptized child with the chrism on the crown of the head crosswise, and the godparents take away their hands, and the priest saith: The same anoint thee with the chrism of his salvation † unto everlasting life. Amen. Peace be with thee and with thy spirit. Thereafter the godparents touch the child, and the priest setteth the chrisom-cap upon the child and saith: Take the white garment, which signifieth the innocence which thou hast received in baptism; the same shalt thou bring without spot before the judgement-seat of Jesus Christ, that thou mayest have eternal life through the merit of Jesus Christ. Peace be with thee and with thy spirit. Then the child is lifted from the font, and when that is done the priest giveth the child a burning candle, which the godparents also take hold of, and saith: Take the burning torch, which signifieth the light of the Christian faith which thou hast now received and vowed in baptism, and keep thy baptism unblameable, that when the Lord cometh to the marriage thou mayest run to meet him with all the saints into the heavenly hall, that thou mayest have eternal life in Christ Jesus. Amen.

Pfalz-Neuburg 1543. Pfalz-Neuburg copied the Brandenburg rite, with its defence of the chrism (Sehling 13, pp. 46–47), word for word in its substance. Its anointings read: **Pfalz-Neuburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1543** (Sehling 13, p. 55):

Thereupon the priest anointeth the child with the oil of catechumens, first on the breast, and saith: So I anoint thee with the oil of gladness in Christ † Jesus. And straightway the priest taketh the child in his hands and holdeth it over the font, and anointeth it also between the shoulders, and saith: Our † Lord. […] Then the priest anointeth the baptized child with the chrism on the crown crosswise, and the godparents take away their hands, and he saith: The same anoint thee with the chrism of salvation unto everlasting life! Amen. Peace be with thee and with thy spirit! Thereafter the godparents touch the child again, and the priest setteth the chrisom-cap upon it

Pfalz-Neuburg gives no candle. Its chrism did not last: Ottheinrich suspended the chrism section and issued a new baptismal order (Sehling 13, p. 22, editor's note; §13.15.4).

The same order has the salt: "N., take the salt of wisdom, that thou mayest have eternal life in Christ Jesus our Lord'" (Sehling 3, p. 56). Brandenburg-Nürnberg had already ruled against the oil in 1528, because it was given "in the meaning" that the child was thereby anointed with the Holy Ghost. **Brandenburg-Nürnberg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1528** (Sehling 11, p. 135):

And although it seemeth as though to anoint the children with oil should be free, yet it is not free to anoint the child in the meaning that it be thereby anointed with the Holy Ghost: for God hath neither bidden nor promised that he will give his Spirit just there where one anointeth with oil. But since it was set up by the papists in that meaning, it shall be let fall, likewise the salt, spittle and clay.

13.3.3 Luther's revised *Taufbüchlein* of 1526: the Lutheran standard

In 1526 Luther reissued the book shortened. Sehling's headnote lists the orders that took it over: Göttingen 1530, Brandenburg-Nürnberg 1533, Northeim 1539, Duke Henry's Saxon agenda 1539, Halle 1541, Schleswig-Holstein 1542, Pomerania 1542, Schweinfurt 1543, Ritzebüttel 1544 and Mecklenburg 1552 (Sehling 1, p. 21). The whole rite is short enough to give entire.
Luther, *Das taufbuchlin verdeudscht aufs neu zu gericht*, 1526 (Sehling 1, pp. 22–23):

Let the baptizer say: Depart, thou unclean spirit, and give place to the Holy Ghost. Then let him make a cross on its forehead and breast and say: Receive the sign of the holy cross, both on the forehead and on the breast. Let us pray. O almighty everlasting God, Father of our Lord Jesus Christ, I call upon thee for this N., thy servant, who asketh the gift of thy baptism and desireth thy everlasting grace through the spiritual new birth. Receive him, O LORD, and as thou hast said, "Ask, and ye shall receive; seek, and ye shall find; knock, and it shall be opened unto you", so give now the good thing to him that asketh, and open the door to him that knocketh: that he may obtain the everlasting blessing of this heavenly washing and receive the promised kingdom of thy gift, through Christ our Lord. Amen. Let us pray. Almighty everlasting God, who by the flood didst according to thy strict judgement condemn the unbelieving world, and according to thy great mercy didst preserve believing Noah, himself the eighth, and didst drown hardened Pharaoh with all his in the Red Sea, and didst lead thy people Israel through dry, thereby signifying beforehand this washing of thy holy baptism, and by the baptism of thy dear Child, our Lord Jesus Christ, didst hallow and ordain Jordan and all waters to be a blessed flood and an abundant washing away of sins: we pray through the same thy bottomless mercy, that thou wouldest graciously look upon this N. and bless him with right faith in the spirit, that by this saving flood there may be drowned in him and go under all that is born in him from Adam, and that he himself hath added thereto; and that he, being severed from the number of the unbelieving, kept dry and safe in the holy ark of Christendom, may serve thy name always fervent in spirit, joyful in hope, that with all the faithful he may be made worthy to obtain thy promise of everlasting life, through Jesus Christ our Lord. Amen. I adjure thee, thou unclean spirit, in the name of the Father † and of the Son † and of the Holy Ghost †, that thou come out and depart from this servant of Jesus Christ, N. Amen. Let us hear the holy gospel of Saint Mark. At that time they brought young children to Jesus, that he should touch them. But the disciples rebuked those that brought them. When Jesus saw it, he was much displeased, and said unto them: Suffer the little children to come unto me, and forbid them not, for of such is the kingdom of heaven. Verily I say unto you, whosoever shall not receive the kingdom of God as a little child, he shall not enter therein. And he took them up in his arms, and put his hands upon them, and blessed them. Then let the priest lay his hands on the child's head and pray the Our Father together with the godparents, kneeling. […] Then let the child be led to the font and the priest say: The Lord preserve thy going in and thy coming out from this time forth for evermore. Then let the priest cause the child through its godparents to renounce the devil, and say: N., renouncest thou the devil? Answer: Yes. And all his works? Answer: Yes. And all his ways? Answer: Yes. Then let him ask: Believest thou in God the Father almighty, maker of heaven and earth? Answer: Yes. Believest thou in Jesus Christ his only Son our Lord, born and suffered? Answer: Yes. Believest thou in the Holy Ghost, one holy Christian church, the communion of saints, forgiveness of sins, resurrection of the flesh, and after death an everlasting life? Answer: Yes. Wilt thou be baptized? Answer: Yes. Then let him take the child and dip it in the font and say: And I baptize thee in the name of the Father and of the Son and of the Holy Ghost. Then shall the godparents hold the child in the font, and the priest say, while he putteth on the chrisom-robe: The almighty God and Father of our Lord Jesus Christ, who hath begotten thee again through water and the Holy Ghost, and hath forgiven thee all thy sins, strengthen thee with his grace unto everlasting life. Amen. Peace be with thee. Answer: Amen.

The 1526 order thus keeps:

- one exorcism at the door ("Depart") and one before the Gospel ("I adjure thee");
- the sign of the cross;
- the prayer "Receive him" and the Flood prayer;
- Mark 10 and the Lord's Prayer with the laying on of hands;
- the procession to the font with Psalm 121:8;
- the threefold renunciation and the threefold creed, answered by the godparents in the child's name;
- "Wilt thou be baptized?", immersion, the *Westerhemd* (christening robe) and the closing blessing.

It drops salt, spittle, oil, chrism, candle and the second set of prayers and exorcisms.

13.3.4 The Saxon agenda and Brandenburg-Nürnberg: exhortations around Luther's rite

The territorial agendas did not change Luther's 1526 text, but framed it with teaching.

Saxony 1539. Duke Henry's agenda opens with an exhortation to "those who bring children to baptism". It sets out original sin and Christ's command to bring the children to him, and asks the bystanders to "help to pray". Then comes Luther's rite. **Saxony**

(Albertine), *Kirchenordnung*, 1539 (Sehling 1, p. 266):

In the manner following shall the pastors address and exhort the people that bear children to baptism. Dear friends in Christ, we hear every day out of God's word, and find it also, both in our life and in our dying, that from Adam onward we are all conceived and born in sins, wherein we must be under God's wrath condemned and lost for ever, if we were not helped out of them by the only-begotten Son of God, our dear Lord Jesus Christ. [...] therefore of Christian love take earnestly upon you also the cause of this present poor little child before God the Lord, bear it to the Lord Christ, and help to pray for the forgiveness of sins, and that it may be received also into the kingdom of grace and salvation.

The editions from 1540 and from 1555 (Sehling's A and B) add two things. One is a short sermon on the Gospel "if there be time and the child is not weak". The other is a long address to the godparents before the renunciation, binding them to see the child taught the commandments, creed and Lord's Prayer. It ends with the godparents' "yes" and the minister's "This grant us our dear Lord God, and fulfil with his grace what we are not able'" (Sehling 1, p. 267). Both may be left out "where it would be too long or the child is weak".

Brandenburg-Nürnberg 1533. The Franconian order recast Luther's 1526 epilogue as a spoken admonition: "Dearly beloved! I exhort and pray you all ...'" (Sehling 11, p. 178). It then gave Luther's rite with the full Apostles' Creed in the second question. It added a charge to the godparents after the baptism, which many later orders copied. **Brandenburg-Nürnberg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1533** (Sehling 11, p. 180):

After the baptism shall the pastors or ministers of the church exhort the godparents somewhat after this manner: I exhort you, by virtue of the Christian love which ye have now shown in the child's stead at the baptism, that if it should be bereaved of its parents by death or other mishap before it come to the use of its reason, ye will diligently and faithfully instruct it and teach it first the ten commandments, that it may thereby learn to know the will of God and its sin; then the Christian faith, through which we receive grace, forgiveness of sins and the Holy Ghost; lastly also the Our Father, that it may call upon God and pray for help to withstand Satan and to live as a Christian, until God fulfil in it what he hath now begun in baptism, and it be saved.

13.3.5 The Upper German rite: Strasbourg and Württemberg

Württemberg 1536. Brenz's first Württemberg order kept Luther's spoken admonition, the prayer "Receive him", the Flood prayer, the Gospel and the Lord's Prayer. It has no exorcism and no sign of the cross, and it does not have the renunciation or the creed. There is one question to those who bring the child, and the child is sprinkled three times. **Württemberg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1536** (Sehling 16, p. 113):

Then let the child be borne to the font and the priest ask those that have borne the child thither, to this effect: Dearly beloved, ye desire that this child be baptized into Christ Jesus and be incorporated into his holy congregation through the outward sign of baptism. Thereto shall they answer: Yes. Then he taketh the child and sprinkleth it three times with water and saith: N., I baptize thee in the name of the Father and of the Son and of the Holy Ghost; and let him say thereupon: The almighty God and Father of our Lord Jesus Christ, who hath begotten thee again through water and the Holy Ghost and hath forgiven thee all thy sins, strengthen thee with his grace unto everlasting life. Amen. Peace be with thee. Amen.

Württemberg 1553. The great order of 1553 became the form of the south-west. Sehling's apparatus records its baptism in the Baden orders of 1556 and 1598 and in Mömpelgard in 1560 and 1571, and Nassau-Weilburg in 1576 opens its baptism with the same words. Its order is:

1. The name is asked, and whether the child was baptized in an emergency.
2. **An opening address** (*Form des Tauffs*): a child is brought "to be commended to the prayer of the common Christian church".
3. **The Gospel of the children** (Mark 10), read first.
4. **An exhortation** on original sin and Christ's love for children.
5. **Two prayers**: "Receive him", and the Flood prayer as an alternative (*Ein ander Gebett*).
6. **The Lord's Prayer.**
7. Psalm 121:8 over the child.
8. **An address to the godparents**: whoever joins the church "entereth a spiritual battle".
9. **Renunciation** in one question, and **the Apostles' Creed** in three questions.
10. "Wilt thou be baptized thereon?"
11. **Pouring** on the unwrapped child, "with clear, loud and distinct voice".

12. **The blessing** "The almighty God".
13. **A thanksgiving prayer**, then **an admonition** to parents, kin and godparents to bring the child to the catechism.

The rubric on the mode of baptism declares immersion, pouring and sprinkling all indifferent. It then orders pouring on the naked child, except in cold weather or weakness. **Württemberg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1553** (Sehling 16, pp. 232–233):

But that the child in baptizing be wrapped or unwrapped, poured upon once or three times, dipped into the water or sprinkled with water, is in itself indifferent. Yet, since in the church all things should be done orderly and to edifying, we have thought it profitable that the children be unwrapped, yet, to prevent all manner of danger, not dipped into the water, but poured upon with the water naked as they are, unless it be that the child be so weak that it could not well bear the air or the cold; then it may well be baptized wrapped.

Strasbourg 1537 (Moderate Reformed). Strasbourg had moved furthest from the old rite. Its agenda sets fixed times for baptism: in the Minster on Sundays after the noon sermon and on Wednesdays after the morning sermon, and in the other parishes at Sunday vespers. The service is a sermon in brief, with four heads of exhortation. Then come silent prayer, two prayers, the Gospel, the creed said by all, an address to the whole congregation and the godparents, threefold pouring, a thanksgiving and a dismissal. There is no exorcism, no cross and no question to the godparents. The words at the font are these. **Strasbourg, *Agende*, 1537** (Moderate Reformed; Sehling 20/1, p. 269):

Hereupon the minister desireth the child to be given him in order. This he then taketh in his hands, uncovereth it, and when he hath asked what it shall be called, nameth it with its name, poureth upon it thrice and saith: N., I baptize thee in the name of the Father and of the Son and of the Holy Ghost. Amen. […] Go hence in peace. The Lord grant that his holy angels, which see his face in heaven, may keep this child (these children) from all evil and further it unto all good. Amen.

13.3.6 The Reformed rite: the Palatinate 1563

The Reformed Palatine order of 1563 drew its baptism from Zurich, Geneva, Frankfurt and the London strangers' church (all Reformed) (Sehling's notes, Sehling 14, pp. 337–341). It begins with the *adjutorium* (Our help) "Our help standeth in the name of the Lord". There follows a long exhortation on the three names: the Father as the covenant God of us and our seed, the Son as Saviour, the Spirit as teacher and comforter. The children's right to baptism is drawn from the covenant with Abraham and from Mark 10. Then come:

- the Flood prayer, recast so that the waters "signify" baptism and the child is asked to be "engrafted" into Christ;
- the Lord's Prayer;
- the Apostles' Creed, said "with me" by all;
- one question to the parents and godparents;
- the uncovering of the head only;
- pouring with the formula;
- a thanksgiving and a charge to the parents and godparents.

There is no exorcism, no renunciation by the godparents in the child's name, no sign of the cross and no *Westerhemd* (christening robe). **Kurpfalz, *Kirchenordnung*, 1563** (Reformed; Sehling 14, p. 340):

Question. Do ye then desire, out of true faith in the promise of God in Jesus Christ which is given to us and to our children, that he will be not only our God but also the God of our seed unto the thousandth generation, that this child be baptized thereupon and receive the sealing of the adoption of God? Answer: Yes. Here it is not needful to unwrap the child, but enough that its head be uncovered. And then let the minister of the church bid them name the child, and thereafter let him pour water upon it and say: N., I baptize thee in the name of God, the Father, the Son and the Holy Ghost.

The same order reserves baptism to ministers of the Word and forbids baptism by any person "to whom the office of preaching is forbidden". This was directed, Sehling notes, against the emergency baptism allowed in the Palatine order of 1556. It requires baptism in the assembled congregation, the presence of the father and the keeping of a baptismal register. **Kurpfalz, *Kirchenordnung*, 1563** (Reformed; Sehling 14, p. 337):

In these words the Lord Christ commandeth those only to baptize who are called to preach his holy Word, and so bindeth both, preaching and baptizing, together in one commandment and office. Therefore it behoveth no creature to sunder this commandment and to allow baptizing to a person to whom the office of preaching is forbidden. Therefore shall the children, at

every fit time when it is orderly desired on their behalf and they are brought into the church before the ministers of the Word, be baptized by the preachers. And this shall be done chiefly on Sunday, holy day or otherwise in the week when the congregation of God is gathered, that every one may know to remember his baptism, and the Christian congregation with one accord call upon the name of God over the child.

13.3.7 Emergency baptism and its confirmation in church

Every Lutheran order allowed baptism in danger of death by the midwife or any Christian. All forbade rebaptism "under condition", and most printed a form for receiving the child in church if it lived. This is the *Bestätigung der Nottaufe*, later called "confirmation of emergency baptism". The Saxon form of 1539 was the model, taken word for word into Brandenburg 1540 and many others. The pastor asks five questions:

1. Was the child brought to Christ and baptized?
2. By whom, and who was present?
3. Did you call upon God and pray?
4. With what did you baptize?
5. With what words?

If the answers are sure, he declares the baptism right, reads Mark 10 and prays the closing blessing of the rite. If they are unsure, the child is baptized "as unbaptized", without condition. **Saxony (Albertine), *Kirchenordnung*, 1539** (Sehling 1, pp. 267–268):

Then let him ask further: Wherewith did ye baptize? If they answer: With water, then let him ask: With what words did ye baptize? If they then say: I baptize thee in the name of the Father, and of the Son, and of the Holy Ghost, then let him ask lastly: Know ye that ye used the words according to the command of Christ? And if they answer thereto: Yes, we know it, then he saith: Now, my dear friends, since ye have done all this in the name and by the command of our dear Lord God, I say that ye have done right and well […] But if the people that bring the child to baptism should give uncertain answer to the pastor's question, and say they knew not what they thought, much less what they said or did in such great need (as is then wont often to happen), let there be no great disputing, but let the child be taken as unbaptized and brought forward to baptism, as all the unbaptized are wont to be brought forward and baptized.

Württemberg in 1536 required the midwife to call two or three witnesses. Brandenburg-Nürnberg in its 1591 revision added a question that betrays the old practice of baptism in the womb: "Whether the child was fully born and quite free of the mother when it was baptized?'" (Sehling 11, p. 181). For "no child shall be baptized in emergency that is not wholly born into the world."

Brandenburg-Nürnberg in 1528 asked that strong children wait for the next feast day, "that such baptism take place in the presence of so much the more people". In danger they were to be brought at once or baptized at home. Later orders set limits: three days (Schulenburg 1572), eight days (Pfalz-Zweibrücken 1557; Leiningen 1584). The Reformed Palatinate in 1563, as above, abolished emergency baptism by laypeople outright.

13.3.8 Godparents, feasts and registers

Number and quality. The orders limited the number of godparents and excluded the openly wicked. Württemberg 1553 forbade "frivolous persons, who are bound in public vices without repentance" (Sehling 16, p. 233). The Palatinate 1563 (Reformed) had the father consult the minister in advance about the godparents (Sehling 14, p. 338). Breslau held to a rule, confirmed by the council eighty years before, of three godparents only (Sehling 3, p. 402). Duke August's Saxon order set the same limit under a fine of a hundred gulden. **Saxony, *Ordnung* of Duke August, 1580** (Sehling 1, p. 426):

so shall henceforth no more than three godparents be bidden, under the penalty laid of a hundred gulden, which we will hereby have renewed, and none be admitted above this.

The christening feast. The *Kindtaufe* meal was regulated with the wedding. Sarcerius's Mansfeld visitation form of 1554 lists, among the faults to be punished, more than three godparents, more than eight women at the meal, and men at the meal at all. **Mansfeld, *Form und weise einer visitation*, 1554** (Sehling 2, p. 192):

Not to bid more than three godparents to the christening. That not more than eight women shall eat at the christening. That no men go to the christening to eat or drink there.

Registers. The Palatinate in 1563 (Reformed) ordered the minister to enter "the name of the father, the mother, the child and the godparents" in a book kept at every church (Sehling 14, p. 338). Pfalz-Veldenz did the same in its Lützelstein order of 1605 (Sehling 18, p. 596).

The vows asked of godparents are treated in Chapter 17, §17.17.4.

13.3.9 The baptism of adults and of Jews

The rite assumed infants. The orders made room for adults in three ways:

- **A clause in the Flood prayer.** Luther's words "and that he himself hath added thereto" were marked in Württemberg as the clause to add "when an older person is baptized" (Sehling 16, pp. 112, 234).
- **The Hessian catechumenate.** The Hessian order of 1566 (Moderate Reformed) described the ancient catechumenate at length. Its section on baptism was taken into the Austrian agenda of 1571 as "a short Christian instruction for baptizing older persons" (Sehling 8, p. 268). In the ancient church, it says, the instructed made their confession "before the whole congregation on certain appointed feasts". They renounced the devil, confessed the creed and were baptized "in and before the whole church, which looked on".
- **Separate forms for Jews.** Sehling notes a liturgical form for the baptism of an adult Jew among the Mainz possessions, "perhaps the first in the evangelical church" (Sehling 2, p. 365). He prints a Friedberg *Judentaufformular* of about 1600. There the baptism followed catechetical instruction and examination and was done in the service of the congregation (Sehling 9, pp. 625, 635–637).

13.4 Exorcism

The orders mean three different things by exorcism:

- the **baptismal exorcism**: the "Depart" at the door, and the adjurations "I adjure thee" in the rite (§13.3);
- the **exorcisms of creatures**: the exorcisms of salt and water in the blessing of holy water and the baptismal font, treated with the other blessings in §13.15;
- the **exorcism of the possessed**, the work of the minor order of exorcist and of the "devil banishers". This is treated with the rites for the sick in §13.8.

Only the first was in dispute among evangelicals. For the minor order of exorcist see Chapter 16 §16.3.

13.4.1 Luther's exorcism and its defenders

Luther's view. Luther kept a shortened exorcism in 1526 and defended it as an earnest act of the church: "it is no jest to deal against the devil". In his epilogue the church "confesseth before God that the child is possessed of the devil" (Sehling 1, p. 21).

Dietrich's gloss: the exorcism is a prayer. The Lutheran defenders explained the formula as a confession of original sin and a kind of prayer, not a charm. Veit Dietrich's Nuremberg agenda put a gloss against the "I adjure thee" to say so. **Nuremberg, *Agendbüchlein* of Veit Dietrich, 1545** (Sehling 11, p. 506):

I adjure thee, thou unclean spirit (margin: This exorcism is not wrong; for it is even as a prayer), in the name of the Father and of the Son and of the Holy Ghost, that thou come out and depart from this servant (this handmaid) of Jesus Christ, N. Amen.

Zweibrücken 1539: optional, but grounded in the fathers. The Zweibrücken order kept it "where it can fitly be kept". It appealed to the fathers and to its use in showing "what harm original sin bringeth". **Pfalz-Zweibrücken, *Form und Ordnung*, 1539** (Sehling 18, p. 59):

The exorcism, where it can fitly be kept or is [kept], remaineth. Almost the whole Christian church hath used it, as Saint Augustine showeth, *De ecclesiasticis dogmatibus* (Of the doctrines of the church), chapter 21, and it is very serviceable to show what harm original sin bringeth, and how the devil, a prince of the world, is driven out by Christ alone.

Verden 1606: a reminder, not a cause. The late Lutheran orders kept it under an explicit caveat. The Verden order of 1606 says the child is rescued by baptism, not by the exorcism. Sehling's editor notes that the exorcism was kept in the Lüneburg, Wolfenbüttel and Mecklenburg orders as well. **Stift Verden, *Kirchenordnung*, 1606** (Sehling 7/1, p. 172):

Here it is to be noted: since in the churches of this our foundation of Verden we have kept the exorcism for weighty causes well grounded in God's word, the preachers shall from time to time remind the people that it be in no wise so understood as though the child were taken and rescued out of the power of the devil through the exorcism, and not rather through holy baptism; but that it is only a reminder in what great need and perilous misery the little child is sunk by reason of its sins, why holy baptism is needful for it, and what is wrought in the little children thereby.

Other late Lutheran orders took the same line:

- **Schaumburg 1614** kept it "as an outward ceremony ordained by the most ancient teachers of the church, in its free use hitherto" (Sehling 7/2.2, p. 151).
- **Soest 1609** kept it but left it free to the preachers. It cited Polycarp Leyser's *Vom Exorcismo* (Of exorcism) against the "Anhalt sacramentarians" (Sehling 22, p. 492).
- **Pomerania 1569** forbade anyone to dispute the exorcism and the crosses in public, and ruled that the child might be baptized naked or with only the head bared, "for one baptizeth not the swaddling clothes but the man". **Pomerania, *Kerckenordeninge*, 1569** (Sehling 4, p. 386):

Holy baptism shall be held with the ceremonies that are written in the catechism and in the agenda, and none shall be suffered to dispute openly of the exorcism or the crosses which stand in the catechism; the children shall also be baptized without distinction, naked, or only on the head in the swaddling clothes, and no disputation or trouble be made hereof, for one baptizeth not the swaddling clothes, but the man.

13.4.2 No exorcism over the child already baptized

Even the orders that kept the exorcism agreed that it must not be read over a child brought to church after emergency baptism. To do so would call the Holy Spirit, who is with the baptized child, an unclean spirit. Bugenhagen gave the reason in Braunschweig in 1528. The same rule stands in Hamburg 1529, Lübeck 1531, the Haderslev articles of 1528, Pomerania 1535, Buxtehude, the Wittenberg town order of 1533 and the Mansfeld agenda of 1580 (Sehling 7/1, p. 73; 23, p. 67; 4, p. 330; 1, p. 703; 2, p. 219). **Braunschweig, *Kirchenordnung*, 1528** (Sehling 6/1, p. 360):

But the priest shall not read the exorcism over the child so baptized, to ban the devil out, lest with the reading he blaspheme the Holy Ghost, who is surely with the baptized child.

13.4.3 Toleration and mitigation

Henneberg 1582: tolerated for a time. Some Lutheran territories held the exorcism free but removed it from the printed rite, tolerating it "for a while" where it was still used. The reason was that, bordering on the papacy, they found it "often thriving into superstition and misuse". **Henneberg, *Kirchenordnung* of Georg Ernst, 1582** (Sehling 2, pp. 304–305):

Of the exorcism. As touching the exorcism or adjuring of the evil spirit, we let the same indeed, in a right and sound understanding, as a confession, or as some will, as a kind of prayer, remain in its worth, and blame no one who keepeth such adjuring in use out of Christian liberty, even as the same may also out of like liberty be left off and done away. Yet we in our place, as bordering on the papacy, have found in practice that it will often thrive among the people into superstition and misuse. […] therefore it is left out in the prescribed action of holy baptism, and it is concluded that such adjuring shall for a while yet be tolerated and allowed to be used, that the common man may be the better and more thoroughly instructed meanwhile in the sermons, and it may then be done away and left off so much the more without offence, yet only in those places of our princely county where it is still in use.

Brandenburg-Ansbach 1591: "I command thee". The Franconian margraviate softened the words of the general visitation of 1591. "I adjure thee" became "I command thee", the crosses were dropped, and the consistory ordered the mitigated form to be used everywhere "to prevent offence and needless strife". **Brandenburg-Ansbach-Kulmbach, *Konsistorialordnung*, 1594** (Sehling 11, p. 392):

Since also the exorcism in our church order hath for weighty causes been mitigated and softened in some words at the general visitation, and the papistical crosses done away, such mitigation shall henceforth be kept alike by the ministers of the church in all places in the principality below and above the mountains, to prevent offence and needless strife, and no division be begun on that account.

Ysenburg-Birstein 1588: let it fall gradually. The Ysenburg order of 1588 directed that the exorcism, "since it hath for the most part fallen among all the orthodox", should not be brought back where it had lapsed, and should be dropped gradually elsewhere. **Ysenburg-Birstein, *Kirchenordnung*, 1588** (Sehling 10, p. 628):

To be noted: since the exorcism hath for the most part fallen among all the orthodox, it shall not be brought in again in those places where it hath not been hitherto. But where it is still kept in use, it shall henceforth be let fall by degrees, so far as may be done without offence of the common people.

13.4.4 Abolition

Strasbourg and the Upper German orders never had the exorcism after the mid-1520s. Württemberg in 1536 and 1553 has none (§13.3.5). Sehling's editor notes that the Kassel order of 1539 (Moderate Reformed) "following Strasbourg forms" leaves it out (Sehling 8, p. 119). The Hessian order of 1566 (Moderate Reformed) also omits it from its two baptismal forms. It mentions "the prayers together with the exorcisms" only in the section on emergency baptism, which it copied from the Saxon agenda (Sehling 8, p. 284).

Abolition by mandate, 1567–1613. From the 1560s the Reformed and Philippist territories abolished it by mandate:

Territory	Date	Source
Upper Palatinate (Amberg; Reformed)	1567	mandate of 20 January (Sehling 13, p. 303)
Nassau-Dillenburg (Philippist)	1575	agenda (Sehling 10, p. 150)
Hohenlohe	1578	order (Sehling 15, p. 235)
Nördlingen	1579	order, at Andreae's wish (Sehling 12, p. 352)
Moers (Reformed)	1581	order (Sehling 22, p. 194)
Waldeck	1584	mandate of 21 August, with the *Westerhemd* (christening robe; Sehling 9, p. 300)
Bentheim-Tecklenburg (Reformed)	1588	order (Sehling 22, p. 269)
Anhalt (Philippist)	1590	princely command of 27 July, and a new *Taufbüchlein* (Sehling 2, p. 531)
Electoral Saxony	1591	under Christian I; Sehling records the negotiations and the "unrest" (Sehling 1, p. 137)
Gottorf	1613	(Sehling 23, p. 324)

Nassau-Dillenburg 1575. The Nassau agenda gives the Reformed case. Baptism by Christ's institution is strong enough against the devil. The exorcism has no ground in Scripture or apostolic tradition, and it breeds an *opinio cultus et necessitatis* (an opinion of worship and of necessity). **Nassau-Dillenburg, *Agende*, 1575** (Philippist; Sehling 10, p. 150):

Secondly, the exorcism and adjuring of the devil shall no more be used at baptism, for we know and hold holy baptism, according to the institution of our Lord Jesus Christ, without any human tradition, to be strong enough to meet the devil and to take from him all his power and kingdom. Moreover the exorcism at baptism is not grounded in God's word and the apostolic traditions, and is also needless, and many have yet a superstitious misunderstanding therewith, an *opinion of worship and of necessity*, which darkeneth the work in itself and holdeth the simple back from the consideration of needful things.

Waldeck 1584. The Waldeck counts' mandate abolishing both the exorcism and the *Westerhemd* shows the care taken over the people's consciences. Pastors were to teach that children already baptized with them had been rightly baptized, and that future children would lack nothing. **Waldeck, mandate on the baptismal exorcism and robe, 21 August 1584** (Sehling 9, p. 300):

that henceforth in our churches, for causes especially moving thereto, the exorcism and the chrisom-robe shall be left out at the baptism of little children and no more used [...] And that your congregation be not offended thereat, and do not perchance account it as though their former children were wrongly baptized, or the future ones should not receive a perfect baptism when the said two pieces were left out therewith

Bentheim-Tecklenburg 1588. The Bentheim order states the Reformed objection in a sentence: the exorcisms "have no ground in the Word of God" and were not used at circumcision, nor in the time of Christ and the apostles. **Bentheim-Tecklenburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1588** (Reformed; Sehling 22, p. 269):

that the superstitious ceremonies hitherto used at baptism, and chiefly the exorcisms, which have no ground in the Word of God, and were not in use in the Old Testament at circumcision, nor thereafter in the times of Christ and the holy apostles, and serve rather to darken than to explain baptism and all other ceremonies, be done away

Anhalt 1590: a new baptismal book (Philippist). Sehling describes the Anhalt book. It "agreeth almost wholly with Luther's *Taufbüchlein*". The exorcism formula is left out, and the opening exhortation of Duke Henry's agenda is added (Sehling 2, p. 531). The exorcism thus became the outward sign by which a Lutheran territory was suspected of Calvinism. Sehling notes for Anhalt that the abolition, "objectively taken", involved no change of confession "with the removal of this adiaphoron", but that the estates took it otherwise (Sehling 2, p. 530).

13.5 Churching of women after childbirth

The medieval church received the mother back at her first churching, about six weeks after the birth. The priest "led her in" (*einleiten*, *introductio*) and blessed her (*einsegnen*, *aussegnen*). The rite was modelled on the purification of Leviticus 12, and popular belief held that the woman in childbed was in the devil's power until it was done. The evangelical orders took three positions on it:

- **abolition**, because it implied that childbirth defiled;
- **recasting as a thanksgiving**, the *Kirchgang* (churching) of the *Sechswöchnerin* (woman in childbed);
- **leaving it free**, as a thanksgiving the mother might make of her own accord.

13.5.1 Abolished as a papal superstition

The Saxon visitors of 1540 put "leading in" the bride and the woman after childbirth among the ceremonies to be wholly abolished, with sprinkling, the blessing of salt and water, ringing for souls and ringing against storms. **Saxony (Albertine), *Gemeiner Bericht der Visitatorn*, 1540** (Sehling 1, p. 285):

Of leading in and the like. Henceforth shall be wholly done away the leading in of the bride and of the woman after childbed, sprinkling, the hallowing of salt and water, ringing for the souls and ringing against the weather, and whatever more there is of such things.

The same words recur in the Salza order and the general report for the Meissen district, both of 1540, and in Quedlinburg (Sehling 1, pp. 654, 565; 2, p. 262). Brandenburg-Nürnberg in 1533 joined the abolition to pastoral teaching for the women themselves. Women in childbed are not in the devil's power, and their visions and dreams come from bodily weakness. **Brandenburg-Nürnberg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1533** (Sehling 11, p. 177):

The pastors and preachers shall also instruct the women in childbed that they are not in the power of the devil, as hath hitherto been held, not without especial hurt to consciences, and grossly erred therein. […] Therefore also the blessing after childbed is not needful; for it floweth from mere superstition, as though they were unhallowed by the birth, which cometh of God's blessing. Yet shall they none the less keep within doors their due time, that they do no hurt to themselves and to the little children in their bodily health

The fullest argument is in the order for Thüngen, a lordship in Franconia, of 1564. It gives six reasons against the blessing. One is that it had bred "superstition and sorcery with blessings, St John's Gospel, hallowed waters, salt, herbs, candles and the like". It insists that the six weeks' lying-in be kept for the mother's health, against "hard, tyrannical husbands" who drove their wives back to work on the third or fourth day. And it says that abolishing the blessing does not abolish thanksgiving. **Thüngen, *Kirchenordnung*, 1564** (Sehling 11, p. 740):

We will also abolish it in such wise that the abolishing of the blessing be in no wise meant or understood as though the women in childbed should not show and render to God Almighty due and fitting thanksgiving for the fruit of the womb and for his gracious help, protection and preservation; but they shall be exhorted thereto in many ways, yet withal be taught that such needful thanksgiving is bound to no certain place, hour or time

The Lutheran Harlingerland order of 1573/74 kept the six weeks "not for the sake of the law of Moses, which we in no wise accept". It forbade husbands to force their wives out early, and "rejects the introduction or leading in of the women, as was customary in the papacy" (Sehling 7/1, p. 731).

13.5.2 Kept as a thanksgiving: the *Kirchgang*

Many Lutheran territories kept the mother's first churching as a public thanksgiving at the altar.

Querfurt. The Magdeburg visitors in Querfurt asked "whether he leadeth in the woman after childbirth". Sehling's note records the outcome: the custom had already ceased in the town but not in the villages, and "from now on a thanksgiving shall take place from the pulpit or before the altar when the woman goeth to church" (Sehling 2, p. 460).

Brandenburg. The Brandenburg town recesses of 1558 (Wusterhausen among them) and the visitation and consistorial order of 1573 kept the "laudably received" offering at the altar by the woman at her churching, as by the bride at her wedding, and gave it to the pastor (Sehling 3, pp. 232, 353, 119). A Frankfurt (Oder) church book described in 1600 contained an *Einsegnung der Sechswöchnerinnen in ihrem Kirchgang* (Blessing of women after childbirth at their churching), "as in the Mark agenda of 1572" (Sehling 3, p. 215).

Lippe. The Lippe order kept the churching but left it free. Such a woman "may of her own free mind go to church, thank God and pray further for grace" (Sehling 21, p. 315).

The Mansfeld *Einsegenbüchlein*, 1580. The Mansfeld agenda prints a complete form, the *Einsegenbüchlein* (blessing booklet). The order is:

1. An address to the women.
2. The Lord's Prayer.
3. Psalms 127 and 128.
4. A collect of thanksgiving and intercession for the child.
5. A blessing of the child with the sign of the cross.

Mansfeld, *Kirchen-Agenda*, 1580 (Sehling 2, p. 222):

III. The churching book. What is wont to be read out of God's word and prayed over the women when they bring the children into church after the six weeks. Ye dear women (or where only one person is to be churched, dear woman), since the dear God hath graciously helped you and given you a joyful sight at the birth, hath granted to the child (or the children) holy baptism and to you moreover a joyful churching, ye are bound to thank him therefor and to pray that he will further strengthen you together with the child (or the children) in body and soul, guide and lead you in all good and keep you from all evil. Therefore pray with me thus: [The Our Father follows.] The 127th psalm [the psalm follows]. The 128th psalm [the psalm follows]. Let us pray. O almighty, merciful God, who hast helped this woman in her great anguish (these women in their great anguish) and travail, and hast moreover granted joyful fruit (fruits), and endued it with baptism and the Holy Ghost: we praise thee and thank thee for ever, and pray thee through Jesus Christ thy dear Son that thou wouldest have mercy upon this (these) little child(ren), keep it also from all evil, strengthen it, tend and care for it with thy Spirit, that it may be brought up in right faith and constantly, being obedient to thee always, may praise, honour and glorify thee with all the elect, here and there for ever. Amen. And thou (ye) little child(ren), the Lord bless thee on all thy (you on all your) ways, from this time forth for evermore, †. Amen.

The same agenda adds pastoral rubrics for the hard cases:

- **If the mother dies before her churching**, the midwife brings the child, and a prayer of thanks for the child's birth and baptism is said over it.
- **If the child dies within the six weeks**, the woman is not led to the altar, "for that one should bid her step before the priest to the Lord's altar without her little child might grieve her yet more". She is to go to church quietly with the other Christians.
- **If a woman refuses the churching "out of mere defiance"**, despising the prayers over herself and her child, the pastor is to admonish her. If she will not hear, he is to report her to the superintendent and consistory.

Mansfeld, *Kirchen-Agenda*, 1580 (Sehling 2, p. 223):

When such cases befall that the mothers' little children depart by death before the time of their six weeks is out, the churching is let be, so that such women need not be led to the altar and set before the priest; but they shall (when they are come to their health and the time of their churching is at hand) go silently to church with other Christians, and lay their sorrow, wherein they are by reason of the death of their little children, before our dear Lord God in true humility, and pray in faith for patience and comfort and for further blessing according to God's will. For that one should bid them step before the priest to the altar of the Lord without their little children might perhaps grieve them yet more and more deeply.

Sayn 1590. Sayn printed a long prayer "which the ministers of the church shall use when the women after six weeks go out of childbed to church". It thanks God that he "hath been a faithful helper in need and stood by her in her deadly anguish" (Sehling 19/1, p. 401).

Solms 1599 (Reformed). Solms forbade the woman in childbed to go out before four weeks. She was then to present herself to the pastor, and the christening feast was to be put off until her churching (Sehling 9, p. 340).

13.6 Confirmation

No chrismation. No evangelical order in the corpus anoints at confirmation, and none keeps confirmation as a sacrament. The papal *Firmung* (confirmation) is rejected everywhere: its claim that no one is a full Christian until anointed by the bishop, and its formula "Signo te signo crucis et confirmo te chrismate salutis" (I sign thee with the sign of the cross and confirm thee with the chrism of salvation). The one order that kept the chrism at all, Electoral Brandenburg in 1540, kept it at baptism (§13.3.2), not at confirmation.

What replaced it. Most orders kept or created an evangelical confirmation with three parts:

1. **Instruction** in the catechism.
2. **A public examination and confession of faith** before the congregation, usually at a feast, by children of about ten to fourteen who were to be admitted to the Lord's Supper.
3. **Prayer, usually with the laying on of hands.**

The Saxon orders, by contrast, often treated the examination itself as "the right Christian confirmation" and had no separate rite.

13.6.1 The reformers' proposal

The *Wittenberg Reformation* of 1545, signed by Luther, Melanchthon and the other Wittenberg theologians, proposed confirmation as "a profitable ceremony". It was "not for show", but for the keeping of right doctrine and good discipline.
Electoral Saxony, *Wittenbergische Reformation*, 1545 (Sehling 1, p. 211):

Confirmation. This were most needful in all churches: to hold the catechism on set days, to instruct the youth in all needful articles of Christian doctrine. Thereto might confirmation be set up, namely, when a child is come to its years of discretion, to hear its confession publicly, and to ask whether it would abide by this one divine doctrine and church, and after the confession and promise to make a prayer with laying on of hands. This were a profitable ceremony, not only for show, but much rather serviceable to the keeping of right doctrine and pure understanding, and to good discipline.

13.6.2 Hesse 1539: the Ziegenhain and Kassel forms

Ziegenhain 1539 (Moderate Reformed). The Hessian confirmation, devised with Bucer in the Ziegenhain order on discipline and the Kassel church order of 1539, is the source of most later forms. Sehling's editor traces its spread to Calenberg-Göttingen 1542, Waldeck 1556/57, Braunschweig-Wolfenbüttel 1569 and Hoya 1581, among others (Sehling 8, p. 104, n. 17). The Ziegenhain rule sets out the whole act:

- the children are presented by their parents and godparents at a chief feast;
- the elders and ministers stand round;
- the pastor examines them in the chief articles of faith;
- they give themselves publicly to Christ and his church;
- the congregation prays;
- the pastor lays on hands and admits them to the Lord's table.

Hesse, *Ziegenhainer Zuchtordnung*, 1539 (Moderate Reformed; Sehling 8, p. 104):

The elders and preachers shall also provide that the children who are now brought so far in Christian understanding through the catechisms that they may rightly be admitted to the table of the Lord be presented on a chief feast, as Easter, Pentecost and Christmas, before all the congregation, to the pastor at a place appointed thereto, by their parents and godparents, round about whom the elders and all other ministers of the word shall stand. There shall the pastor question the same children in the chief parts of the Christian faith; and after the children have answered thereto, and have also there publicly given themselves to Christ the Lord and his church, the pastor shall exhort the congregation to pray the Lord for these children for steadfastness and increase of the Holy Ghost, and conclude such prayer with a collect. After all this the pastor shall then lay hands on the same children, and so confirm them in the name of the Lord and establish them in Christian fellowship, and thereupon bid them go to the table of the Lord

13.6.3 A full form: Calenberg-Göttingen 1542

The Calenberg order of Duchess Elisabeth printed a separate *Ordnung der confirmation oder firmung* (Order of confirmation or firming). It took its prayers and formula from the Erfurt edition of the Kassel order. Its rite is:

1. **Times.** Three times a year, at Easter, Pentecost and Christmas, after vespers.
2. **Ministers.** Two or three neighbouring pastors and, if near, the superintendent, "with due reverence".
3. **An exhortation** against the papal *Firmung* (confirmation) and its oil. The ceremony has two parts: *catechesis* and *impositio manuum*.
4. **The hymn** *Kom, heiliger Geist* (Come, Holy Ghost).
5. **The examination** through the whole catechism, "kindly and gently, that they be not frightened".
6. **A bidding and two long prayers**, the first ending in a paraphrase of the Lord's Prayer.
7. **The laying on of hands** on each child, with the formula below.
8. ***Te Deum*** or a psalm of thanks.

The rubric even asks for a place in the middle of the church where all can see and hear. The exhortation gives the order's view of the old rite. **Calenberg-Göttingen, *Ordnung der confirmation oder firmung*, 1542** (Sehling 6/2, pp. 838–839):

For is it not a foolish doctrine wherein they pretend that none can be a Christian, though he have received baptism, unless he be also anointed and confirmed by the bishop? Yea, how will they prove that such oil of confirmation is an oil of salvation? […] But we will let these apes go with their false doctrine and needless anointings, not rob holy baptism of its worth, and ascribe salvation to no bodily oil, but to the Lord Christ alone. Yet since this ceremony of confirming, when it is rightly used, is nevertheless well to be suffered and very profitable to the keeping of discipline among children, we will undertake with God's help to bring the right use of it again into our church

The words at the laying on of hands, taken from Kassel, became the most widely used evangelical confirmation formula. **Calenberg-Göttingen, *Ordnung der confirmation oder firmung*, 1542** (Sehling 6/2, p. 843):

When such prayer is done, the pastor shall lay his hand upon each child severally and say thus: Receive the Holy Ghost, protection and defence against all evil, strength and help unto all good, from the gracious hand of God the Father, the Son and the Holy Ghost. Amen. Thereupon let the congregation sing a psalm of thanks or the *Te Deum laudamus* (We praise thee, O God).

The order is careful to deny that the Spirit is given "for the sake of the outward ceremony of laying on". He is given "for the sake of the word and prayer of the church", for "Augustine calleth such laying on of hands nothing else than prayer" (Sehling 6/2, p. 841).

13.6.4 Brandenburg 1540: confirmation by the bishop

Electoral Brandenburg, which kept its bishops, restored confirmation "according to the old custom". The bishop examines the children at his visitation and confirms with the laying on of hands. Because the bishops were few, pastors might confirm in the presence of one of the bishop's learned men, at Easter and Pentecost. The order describes the ancient use as including a cross on the forehead "that they should not be ashamed of the cross of Christ", but prescribes only the laying on of hands and prayer. **Brandenburg (Electorate), *Kirchenordnung* of Joachim II, 1540** (Sehling 3, p. 59):

We will that confirmation be held according to the old custom, namely thus: when the baptized come to their years, so that they know what they believe and pray, and also know according to the content of the catechism how they ought to live as Christians and lead an honest conversation, they shall be summoned and heard at the bishop's visitation; and where it is found that they have good knowledge of the faith and of Christian conversation, the bishop shall, as is said above, with laying on of hands pray God Almighty that they may remain steadfast therein, be preserved and be strengthened yet more, and so thereupon confirm and establish them.

13.6.5 Mansfeld 1580 and Pomerania 1569: confirmation before first communion

Mansfeld 1580. The Mansfeld agenda ties confirmation to the first communion. The children recite the catechism with Luther's explanation and are examined publicly, and this is announced to the congregation. One of two prayers is said, then hands are laid on with a formula that names the absolution and the sacrament the child now desires. **Mansfeld, *Kirchen-Agenda*, 1580** (Sehling 2, p. 234):

(After one of these prayers the hand is laid on the children, and [the minister] prayeth further thus:) Forasmuch as thou hast (ye have) learned the catechism and made public confession of thy (your) faith before this Christian congregation, and promised to continue steadfastly therein, and desirest (desire) thereupon to receive the absolution and the most worthy sacrament, God grant thee (you) thereto the Holy Ghost, who may rule thee (you), protect thee, and keep thee unto eternal life in right faith and godly obedience, through Christ his Son. Amen. The blessing of God the Father, and of the Son, and of the Holy Ghost come upon thee (you), and abide upon thee (you) for ever. Amen.

Pomerania 1569. The Pomeranian order required confirmation once a year in every parish, or twice in the towns, in Lent and at Michaelmas, after the quarterly catechism examination. It called it "confirmation and benediction" as described in the agenda, which "hath been in use for many years in these Pomeranian churches" (Sehling 4, pp. 385–386). The agenda chapter is headed "Of confirmation, how one shall hear the children in the catechism and bless them before they are admitted to the most worthy sacrament" (Sehling 4, p. 441). **Lauenburg** in 1585 and **Hesse** in 1566 (Moderate Reformed) and 1574 (Philippist) likewise printed confirmation forms with question and answer, and the Hessian form was copied by Nassau-Weilburg (1576), Corvey (1603) and Hanau-Münzenberg (1609, Reformed) (Sehling 5, p. 458; 8, pp. 300, 430; 10, pp. 251, 498; 21, p. 255).

13.6.6 Strasbourg and the south-west

Strasbourg came to confirmation late, against the Anabaptist charge that infant baptism had destroyed church discipline. Marbach's draft order of 1553 has a chapter *Von der kinder firmung* (Of the children's confirmation) and a *Forma* (Form) "as it is held with the children in the parish of St Nicholas". The city clergy approved both in 1557 (Sehling 20/1, pp. 395, 446). Marbach had announced to Bucer in 1551 "a public example of confirmation and imposition of hands, a pious and Christian ceremony, with about twenty boys" after Easter (Sehling 20/1, p. 79, n. 433).

13.6.7 Examination without a rite: Electoral Saxony

The great Saxon order of 1580 did not adopt the laying on of hands. It instructed the pastors to teach the people that the public catechism examination of children and servants is itself "the right Christian confirmation or *Firmung*". This confirmation is the confirming of the faith that the godparents confessed at baptism. **Saxony, *Ordnung* of Duke August, 1580** (Sehling 1, p. 425):

And the pastors and ministers of the church shall diligently instruct the people and inform them on good ground that this is the right Christian confirmation or *Firmung* (confirmation), that is, the confirming of the faith which the godparents confessed in the stead of the newly baptized child, whereon also the child was baptized: namely when they are reminded of it in this examination, and diligently exhorted to follow it all their life long. Which the papists have let alone, and in the stead of this Christian confirmation have set up a show with the children

Waldeck in 1556 used nearly the same words of the papal *Firmung*, "a show full of superstition and error". It nonetheless printed a chapter on "how young boys and girls shall be received into the Christian congregation" (Sehling 9, pp. 283–284). The Reuss lordships ordered that "instead of confirmation" the young be drilled in the catechism through Lent. Those found fit received the sacrament on Maundy Thursday "and are thereafter to be held confirmed Christians" (Sehling 2, p. 156).

13.7 Betrothal, marriage and divorce

Marriage as a "worldly business". For the evangelical orders marriage is not a sacrament but "a worldly business" (*ein weltlich geschäft*), governed by civil law and local custom and judged by the marriage courts. The church's part is to proclaim the banns, to join the couple if asked, and to read God's Word over them, pray and bless. The marriage law itself (the forbidden degrees, parental consent, the marriage courts) lies outside this chapter, except where it gave the pastor a part to play: at the betrothal, at its dissolution, and at divorce and remarriage (§§13.7.8–13.7.10).

What follows is the liturgy:

- the banns;
- the joining (*Trauung*, *Zusammensprechen*), usually at the church door or before the altar;
- the blessing with readings and prayer at the altar (*Einsegnung*, *Einleitung*);
- the wedding service that replaced the nuptial Mass (*Brautmesse*);
- the rules on times, on brides who had fallen, and on widows.

Two formulas divided the country. Luther's North German "I pronounce them joined in marriage" stood against the South German "The marriage bond … I confirm". Sehling's Franconian editor traces both to halves of one medieval formula (Sehling 11, p. 202, n. 21).

13.7.1 Luther's *Traubüchlein*

Luther's *Traubüchlein für die einfeltigen pfarherrn* (Marriage booklet for simple pastors) is dated variously to 1529 and 1534 (Sehling 1, p. 23). It was printed with the Small Catechism and became the Lutheran standard. Its preface gives the principle. Marriage "is a worldly business", and "every town and land" is to keep its own customs, such as two processions to church or one and the number of banns. "But when it is desired of us to bless them before the church or in the church, to pray over them, or also to marry them, we are bound to do the same." The form follows. **Luther, *Traubüchlein*, 1529** (Sehling 1, p. 24):

First, to publish the banns from the pulpit with such words: Hans N. and Greta N. will according to God's ordinance take hold of the holy estate of matrimony; they desire for themselves the common prayer of the church, that they may begin it in God's name and that it may prosper well. And if any have aught to speak against it, let him do it betimes, or hold his peace thereafter. God give them his blessing. Amen. Before the church to marry them with such words: Hans, wilt thou have Greta to thy wedded spouse? Let him say: Yes. Greta, wilt thou have Hans to thy wedded spouse? Let her say: Yes. Here let him have them give the wedding rings to each other, and join their two right hands together, and say: What God hath joined together, let no man put asunder. Forasmuch then as Hans N. and Greta N. desire each other in marriage, and acknowledge the same here openly before God and the world, whereupon they have given each other their hands and wedding rings, I pronounce them joined in marriage, in the name of the Father, and of the Son, and of the Holy Ghost. Amen.

At the altar the minister reads four lessons:

1. **The institution of marriage**, Genesis 2:18, 21–24.
2. **God's commandment for the estate**, Ephesians 5:22–29.
3. **The cross laid on it**, Genesis 3:16–19.
4. **Its comfort**, Genesis 1:27–28, 31 and Proverbs 18:22.

Then he stretches his hands over the couple and prays. **Luther, *Traubüchlein*, 1529** (Sehling 1, p. 24):

Here let him stretch out his hands over them and pray thus: Lord God, who hast created man and woman and ordained them to the married estate, hast blessed them moreover with fruit of the body, and hast therein signified the sacrament of thy dear Son Jesus Christ and of the church his bride: we pray thy bottomless goodness that thou wilt not let this thy work, ordinance and blessing be displaced or marred, but graciously preserve it in us, through Jesus Christ thy Son our Lord. Amen.

Luther's form passed into the Saxon agenda of 1539 ("as in the *Traubüchlein*", Sehling 1, p. 274) and most North German orders. Mansfeld in 1580 prefaced it with a warning against deserters and bigamists and an address to the congregation, and added a second exhortation to the couple (Sehling 2, pp. 223–225).

13.7.2 The South German form: Brandenburg-Nürnberg 1533

The Franconian order adapted Luther "freely" (Sehling's note). Its rite is:

1. **Notice.** The couple are to give the pastor notice "a good time before", so that impediments can be searched out.
2. **The banns.** They are to be proclaimed once in towns and three times in villages, on feast days.
3. **At the church.** The questions; four readings with headings, "In the first place … In the second place …" (Genesis 2, Matthew 19, Ephesians 5, Genesis 3, Genesis 1 and Proverbs 18); the rings ("if they have rings"); the joining of hands; vows spoken after the minister.
4. **The confirmation of the vows.**
5. **Luther's prayer**, then Psalm 128 and the peace.

Several couples may be married together, and the names entered in a register with the baptisms. **Brandenburg-Nürnberg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1533** (Sehling 11, pp. 201–202):

Then let him say: If ye will now perform such duty and troth one to another, give one another the rings thereupon (if they have rings) and give one another your hands! Then let him say it before the man and let him say after him thus: I N. take thee N. to my wedded spouse and plight thee my troth. Likewise shall he say it before the woman also, and thereupon say further: The marriage duty which ye have here vowed one to another before God and his congregation I confirm by command of the Christian congregation, in the name of the Father and of the Son and of the Holy Ghost. Amen. What God joineth together, let no man put asunder.

Württemberg in 1536 and 1553 used the same form, done before "the most convenient altar" after two banns (Sehling 16, p. 114).

13.7.3 Strasbourg 1537: the impediments asked thrice

The Strasbourg agenda puts the church's inquiry into the rite itself:

1. The minister asks the couple whether they will live in marriage and confirm their purpose before the congregation.
2. He calls three times for anyone who knows an impediment.
3. He takes their right hands and asks each for consent.
4. He "strengthens" the vows "by command of the Christian congregation".
5. A lesson (Genesis 2, Matthew 19 or Ephesians 5) and an exhortation under four heads.
6. Psalm 128, silent prayer, a long prayer that paraphrases the Lord's Prayer, and a dismissal with a charge to remember the poor.

Strasbourg, *Agende*, 1537 (Moderate Reformed; Sehling 20/1, pp. 263–264):

Is there any here who knoweth of an impediment to the marriage of these persons by reason of kinship or affinity by God's commandment, as made known to us by our ordinary magistrates; or that either of them were otherwise pledged and bound in marriage to another person; or that they had not promised their marriage honestly and in right order: let him make it known. The first, the second, the third time. Where then nothing is shown, the minister saith further: Forasmuch then as there is none that will gainsay it, God confirm that which he hath wrought in you. […] The marriage duty which ye have here vowed one to another before God and his congregation I strengthen by command of the Christian congregation, in the name of the Father, the Son and the Holy Ghost. Amen.

The prayer has a clause that is left out "when couples are blessed who by God's common order have no children to hope for" (Sehling 20/1, p. 266).

13.7.4 The nuptial Mass replaced

Herford 1532. The medieval wedding Mass was abolished. In its place came the Word, the blessing and, in many places, a wedding sermon and hymns. Herford describes the change: the bridal Mass that used to be sung "before the soup" on the Monday is gone. Instead God's Word is preached and the blessing given, and the couple's offering goes to the poor chest rather than on the altar. **Herford, *Kirchenordnung*, 1532** (Sehling 21, p. 192):

Likewise also, when the bridegroom and the bride go to church on the Monday, it hath been a custom to sing a bridal Mass before the soup, with great blasphemy of God and frivolity of the people. Since this is now by God's grace done away, and in place of the Mass God's word is preached and the blessing given to the bride and bridegroom, it is ordained by our

congregation that the bride and bridegroom with their kin shall henceforth give such an offering into the poor chest instead of the offering upon the altar

The *Brautmesse* in the Ansbach order. The name *Brautmesse* (bridal Mass) survived for the wedding service with its music, as the fees paid to schoolmasters for singing it show (Brandenburg, Sehling 3, pp. 124, 165, 186). The Ansbach *Ordo ecclesiasticus* (Church Order) of 1592 describes one held at a weekday service:

- a wedding sermon in place of the second lesson;
- before it, *Wol dem, der in Gottes furchten steht* (Blessed is he that standeth in the fear of God) or a motet;
- after the joining, *Wo Gott zum haus nicht gibt sein gunst* (If God does not give his favour to the house) or *Dein ehe soltu bewahren rein* (Thou shalt keep thy marriage pure), the commandment stanza of Luther's metrical Decalogue;
- figural music.

Brandenburg-Ansbach-Kulmbach, *Ordo ecclesiasticus*, 1592 (Sehling 11, p. 456):

But when there is a bridal Mass, at which the cantor must be present, this office is put off until about nine o'clock, when the bell is first struck together; and in place of the second lesson (before which baptism is done, if there be a child to baptize) a wedding sermon is read, and also at times delivered from the pulpit. Before it they are wont to sing *Wol dem, der in Gottes furchten steht*, or a motet in figural song. After the joining: *Wo Gott zum haus nicht gibt sein gunst*, or *Dein ehe soltu bewahren rein*, together with the last commandment of the rhymed Decalogue of Dr Luther, or also a motet in figural song

Mansfeld in 1580 lists the hymns "for the bridal Masses": the *Te Deum* (We praise thee, O God) in German, *Am dritten tage eine hochzeit ward* (On the third day there was a marriage; on John 2) and Psalm 127, *Vergebens ist alle mühe* (In vain is all labour) (Sehling 2, p. 236).

13.7.5 Days, hours and banns

The banns were proclaimed one to three times, on Sundays or feast days. The orders varied:

Order	Banns	Source
Württemberg 1536	twice, in the towns and market towns	(Sehling 16, p. 114)
Brandenburg-Nürnberg 1533	once in towns, three times in villages	(Sehling 11, p. 200)
Ysenburg 1587	on three Sundays, the couple applying fourteen days before	(Sehling 10, p. 587)

Hours and days. Konstanz in 1537 (Moderate Reformed) required the banns three or four days before, on a Sunday or feast. It forbade weddings "before daybreak" and the marriage of strangers without inquiry (Sehling 17, p. 415). In much of Lower Saxony the couple went to church on the Monday (Herford, above).

Closed seasons. Weddings were forbidden at the high feasts, in Advent and in Lent. These rules are collected in Chapter 12 §§12.11.3 and 12.12.6.

13.7.6 The bride who had fallen: no wreath

Württemberg 1553. The wreath (*Kranz*, *Kränzlein*) worn by the bride on her way to church (*Kirchgang*) was the sign of maidenhood. The marriage orders forbade it to a bride who had lain with her bridegroom before the marriage was allowed, and with it music, guests and a public wedding feast. **Württemberg, *Eheordnung*, 1553** (Sehling 16, p. 279):

Yet shall they both be punished by reason of the secret lying together before the marriage was allowed and before the going to church; namely, the man shall be laid eight days in the tower on the ground with water and bread, and the woman four days in a women's prison; and moreover music or guests at the wedding shall be forbidden to them both, or that she wear a wreath at the going to church.

Ulm, Baden and Strasbourg. The same rule stands in the Baden marriage order of 1581 and the Ulm *Zuchtordnung* of 1558. Ulm complained of brides "great with child" who went to church "with the procession and other maidenly adornment" as if they were "honourable, unblemished virgins" (Sehling 16, p. 546; 17, pp. 229, 233). Strasbourg in 1544 (Moderate Reformed) complained of the opposite fault: some would not let maidens be named at the *Kirchgang* at all (Sehling 20/1, p. 342).

13.7.7 Widows and widowers

Remarriage was free, but not too soon. Ysenburg-Ronneburg in 1587 and Brandenburg-Ansbach in 1573 forbade widows and widowers to marry within a quarter of a year of their spouse's death (Sehling 10, p. 587; 11, p. 369). Others limited the feast. The lordship of Homburg's wedding and baptism order of 1570 required widowers and widows to go to church without music or bridesmaids and to hold no "gift wedding" (*giftbrutlofft*, the wedding at which gifts were received), only a meal of three dishes at most (Sehling 22, p. 137). Divorced persons might remarry only with the leave of the consistory or marriage judges (Nördlingen 1579; Kurpfalz 1563, Reformed; Sehling 12, p. 346; 14, p. 285).

13.7.8 Betrothal

The betrothal made the marriage. In sixteenth-century law the betrothal (*Verlöbnis*, *Ehegelübde*, *Eheversprechen*, *sponsalia*), sealed by the handshake (*Handschlag*, *Handstreich*), the ring or the *Weinkauf* (betrothal drink) drink, bound the couple, and the church wedding (*Kirchgang*) confirmed it. Hohenlohe's editor notes that the hand-joining and ring of the church rite came from the betrothal, and that in Hohenlohe the betrothal was still held to found the marriage (Sehling 15, pp. 79, 291). The evangelical orders made the betrothal public and brought the pastor into it in three ways:

- **Secret betrothals void.** Betrothals made "in corners", without the knowledge of parents or guardians, were declared null: Saxony 1540 (*winkelehegelübde*), Henneberg 1545, Erbach 1572 and many others (Sehling 1, p. 285; 2, p. 283; 9, p. 450). Luther had advised that "secret betrothals be abolished and count for nothing" (quoted by Sehling 7/2.1, p. 895, editor's note).
- **The pastor's examination.** Before the banns the pastor was to question the betrothed: are they free, are they related within the forbidden degrees, have they their parents' consent? Brandenburg-Ansbach 1556 and Wolfstein 1574 give the questions (Sehling 11, p. 335; 13, p. 584). Nassau-Weilburg in 1576 required those who meant to marry to report to the officers and pastor "before the promise is made and confirmed with the yea" (Sehling 10, p. 268).
- **Betrothal before the pastor.** Wertheim went furthest. Its order of 1530 required every marriage to be "contracted before the pastor, in the presence of the *Schultheiß* and two jurors", and gave the pastor seven questions. The handshake itself was to wait until the banns had been read three times and the couple came "before the church or altar on the wedding day".

Wertheim, *Kirchenordnung*, about 1555, incorporating the instruction of 1530 (Sehling 11, p. 717):

Therefore it pleaseth us that every marriage be contracted before the pastor, in the presence of the *Schultheiß* (mayor) and two jurors. Yet shall the handshake not take place until the couple have been proclaimed and cried three times. […] First he shall ask the persons that desire one another in marriage whether they marry with the favour of their parents and guardians, and whether they can prove that they have obtained favour and consent from them. Secondly he shall ask them whether they have before promised marriage to one another, between them two alone or before others who were not appointed thereto by the lordship. […] Thirdly he shall ask whether there be no hindrance to such marriage, of the degrees or kinship forbidden by God.

The remaining questions ask whether either belongs to a foreign lordship. The couple are then told to settle the dowry now, and to promise nothing "by word or sign" until the wedding day, when the pastor will enter them for the three banns.

13.7.9 Breaking a betrothal

No private dissolution. Because a public betrothal bound, it could not be broken by the parties, their friends or the pastor. Only the consistory or marriage court could release a betrothed person. Prussia in 1575 put it plainly. **Prussia, *Visitationsabschied für Zinten*, 1575** (Sehling 4, p. 153):

But when persons have betrothed themselves publicly to one another in the presence of their parents or guardians, let no man presume to part them from one another by contract or agreement. Neither shall either party of himself count the other free; but whatever errors and divisions fall out in marriage causes, the parties shall bring them before the aforesaid consistory.

Other orders. The Prussian consistory order of 1584 punished both parties and the go-between (*Scheidemann*) who arranged a private separation (Sehling 4, p. 133). Calenberg-Göttingen in 1588 forbade pastors and officers to part betrothed couples who had "changed their minds" without weighty cause (Sehling 6/2, p. 884). The Palatine marriage-court order of 1563 (Reformed) punished one who betrothed a second partner without first obtaining the court's release from the first (Sehling 14, p. 301). The Dresden marriage order of 1556 allowed a betrothed person deserted for two years to be "declared free" if the absent party did

not answer the citation (Sehling 1, p. 344). No order gives a liturgical form for the release; it was a sentence of the court, which the pastor was bound to see before he proclaimed a new betrothal.

13.7.10 Divorce, annulment and the remarriage of the innocent party

Divorce. The orders allowed divorce for adultery and malicious desertion (Matthew 19, 1 Corinthians 7). It was a judgement of the consistory, preceded by an attempt at reconciliation. The Albertine Saxon marriage order of 1556 (Dresden) explained that the court does not part the marriage; the guilty party has broken it, and the court only declares the innocent party free. **Saxony (Albertine), *Dresdener Ehe-Ordnung*, 1556** (Sehling 1, p. 343):

Now when the innocent person complaineth, reconciliation shall first be attempted; and if that be not obtained, and the innocent person desireth to be declared free, the judge, after inquiry whether the complaining person have a good report, shall declare her free and permit her to enter again into a Christian state of marriage with another person. And this marriage is not severed by the judge, but by the guilty person, who wilfully teareth his estate of marriage contrary to God's will and setteth himself in God's judgement and wrath; but the judge declareth according to God's word that the innocent person is free

Annulment. A marriage void from the beginning was not dissolved but declared null. The Palatine marriage-court order of 1563 (Reformed), on impotence existing before the marriage, says that the other party is declared free, "which also is properly no divorce, but only a declaration and explanation that between them there hath never been a marriage". **Palatinate, *Ehegerichtsordnung*, 1563** (Reformed; Sehling 14, p. 327):

Hereupon, if a spouse be before the beginning of the marriage unfit or unable for marriage by nature or otherwise by accident, so that among right, honest and God-fearing people it is not to be hoped, without a miracle of God, through the ordinary means which God hath given us against such infirmities as befall, that the spouse will ever become fit for the duties of marriage, then such a one can have no right and natural marriage with another. Therefore the other shall be counted free; which also is properly no divorce, but only a declaration and explanation that between them there hath never been a marriage.

The remarriage of the innocent party. The church's one liturgical act in divorce came at the remarriage. The innocent party might marry again, but quietly. Brandenburg-Ansbach's marriage court of 1567 required "a quiet church-going and wedding", and the proclamation summoning a deserting spouse was read from the pulpit of the parish where he had lived (Sehling 11, p. 374). Electoral Brandenburg in 1573 gave the procedure: the bill of divorce shown to the pastor four weeks before, no public banns, and the marriage in the house before two tables of kin. **Brandenburg (Electorate), *Visitation- und Consistorialordnung*, 1573** (Sehling 3, p. 128):

When the innocent divorced person will marry again, he shall show the pastor under whom the wedding is to take place the bill of divorce which he hath obtained from our consistory, four weeks before, and inform him that he hath thereupon promised himself in marriage to another and is minded to be wedded; and the pastor shall not proclaim them publicly, but shall meanwhile inquire and search diligently whether there be any other hindrance [...] If he find none, the wedding shall be set on a convenient day, and some two tables of kinsfolk, besides the priest, invited thereto, and the marrying done in the house without any public wedding pomp; that every man may see that this is no matter of choice but of necessity, whereby the innocent party is helped.

13.8 The sick, the dying, the condemned and the possessed

The orders handle the sick with private ministry rather than with a fixed rite:

- instruction and comfort;
- private confession and absolution;
- communion in the house.

The medieval "last rites" were dismantled. Extreme unction disappears. The reserved sacrament is no longer carried through the streets: the minister consecrates bread and wine at the bedside. The candle in the dying person's hand is taken away. What remains is the Word, the absolution, the sacrament and prayer. The same pastoral pattern was applied to the condemned criminal and, in Pomerania, to the possessed.

13.8.1 Extreme unction

Abolished. No evangelical order prescribes the anointing of the sick. The orders give three reasons: it has no command of Christ; the anointing of James 5 belonged to the apostolic gift of healing and cannot now be used "according to St James's meaning"; and it had been turned into a sacrament of the dying. In its place stand the Word, the absolution, the Supper and the prayer of the church, which is what James 5:14–16 actually commands.

One survival in 1524. Prior Volprecht's German Mass at Nuremberg in 1524 still allowed "if any at his last end desire the anointing, it shall be given him" (Sehling 11, p. 44). The Ansbach visitors of 1528 already asked the clergy "what the right Christian unction and visitation of the sick may be" (Sehling 11, p. 127).

Zweibrücken 1539: James 5 read as a visitation. The Zweibrücken order explains James 5 as the calling of the elders to comfort and pray for the sick, which the church now does with the gospel, the reminder of baptism and the Supper, given in the presence of other Christians. The oil it lets fall. **Pfalz-Zweibrücken, *Form und Ordnung*, 1539** (Sehling 18, p. 61):

Of visiting the sick. To the sick the elders, that is, the ministers of the congregation, were called, to comfort them and pray God for them; whereof James 5: The prayer of faith shall help the sick, and the Lord shall raise him up, and if he have committed sins, they shall be forgiven him. Now the merciful God hath given the holy gospel for a comfort to those whom sin and death affright and drive to despair, and hath ordained the holy sacraments thereto. Therefore we comfort the sick both with the preaching of the holy gospel and with the giving of the holy sacrament of the body and blood of Christ, and remind them of the baptism they have received [...] But the oil, since it cannot be used according to St James's meaning, and misunderstanding and misuse have arisen, and it is also no sacrament nor commandment of the Lord, we leave aside.

Lippe 1538: the Gospel instead of the last oil. The Lippe order has a short chapter "Of the last oil": the oil, used among the Jews for the healthy, was given to the sick without ground in Scripture, and the gospel and Christian prayers are to be read in its place. **Lippe, *Kirchenordnung*, 1538** (Sehling 21, p. 319):

Of the last oil. The last oil, which hath also been appointed for the sick without ground of divine Scripture, and which was used among the Jews for the behoof of the healthy, shall be done away; and instead thereof the gospel and other Christian prayers shall be read, whereby the sick may be comforted and strengthened in faith.

Freiberg 1537. The Albertine visitors at Freiberg ordered in one breath that the sacrament no longer be reserved or carried about, that "the anointing shall henceforth also be done away", and that the sick be communed in German in the presence of others of the household (Sehling 1, p. 466).

13.8.2 No reserved sacrament: communion in the house

The ciboria broken. The reserved sacrament was carried through the streets to the sick in procession, with bell and light, and the reformers made this a chief complaint. The Wittenberg consistory in 1542 ordered all ciboria broken up and communion held at the sickbed. **Electoral Saxony, *Constitution und artikel des geistlichen consistorii zu Wittemberg*, 1542** (Sehling 1, p. 202):

Item they shall take heed that the holy sacrament be not kept in ciboria, nor carried over the streets after the papistical use, but [that they] hold the communion with the sick; therefore all ciboria shall be and remain broken down.

Brandenburg-Nürnberg in 1533 ("they shall not keep, lock up nor carry about the holy sacrament", Sehling 11, p. 184), Hohenlohe in 1553 and Thomas Stieber's instruction for Wolfstein in 1574 say the same (Sehling 15, p. 77; 13, p. 574). The visitors' order for Belgern ordered the pastor "not to keep the host in the sacrament-house any more, but to consecrate it with the sick" (Sehling 1, p. 525).

Not a private Mass. Württemberg in 1536 answered the objection that communion in a house was a "private Mass" (*Winkelmesse*). The minister does not commune himself but gives the sacrament to another, and the sick man "is not excommunicate by reason of his sickness, but rather by reason of the sickness, if he believe, in the communion of all saints". **Württemberg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1536** (Sehling 16, p. 111):

So the sick man is not *excommunicatus* (excommunicate) by reason of his sickness, but is rather by reason of the sickness, if he believe, *in communione omnium sanctorum* (in the communion of all saints); therefore the Sacrament of Communion belongeth to him also, and shall in no wise be withheld from him, to the comfort of his conscience.

The Württemberg order is:

1. 1 Corinthians 11 is read, with a short exhortation.
2. The sick man is heard alone, the others being sent out, and taught and comforted.
3. The general confession and absolution.
4. The consecration with the Words of Institution.
5. Distribution, comfort from the Gospel, and commendation to God.

Reservation outside the sick-call, the Good Friday rite and the consuming of the remaining elements are treated in §§13.22.3–13.22.5.

13.8.3 The Saxon form for the sick, 1539

Duke Henry's agenda gives the order most widely copied in the north. Duke August's order of 1580 reprinted it "word for word" (Sehling 1, p. 370). It has three parts.

Instruction and comfort. "How sick folk shall be instructed and comforted" is an address in four points:

1. Sickness comes for sin.
2. Christ cleanses us through the Gospel and the sacraments, and will cleanse our nature at the last.
3. Sickness and death are sent in grace, to drive us to repentance and faith.
4. All our sins are laid on Christ.

The address ends: "The Lord is my light, whom shall I fear? … into thy hands I commend my spirit'" (Sehling 1, pp. 269–270).

Absolution. It is given in the form for private confession, which ends "Go hence in peace".

Communion. The Saxon order of communion is printed below. **Saxony (Albertine), *Kirchenordnung*, 1539** (Sehling 1, pp. 270–271):

How the sick shall be communicated. When the sick person hath first been instructed by God's word and comforted with the word of absolution, let the table be made ready with bread and wine honourably, with a cloth laid upon it etc., for the communion; and when that is done, let a fine comfortable psalm of prayer be said before the sick person, as the twenty-fifth: Unto thee, O Lord, do I lift up my soul; O my God, I trust in thee: let me not be ashamed, let not mine enemies triumph over me, etc., or such like short psalms. After the psalm let a comfortable text out of the gospel be read to the sick person, as about this, John 3: For God so loved the world, that he gave his only begotten Son, that whosoever believeth in him should not perish, but have everlasting life. After the gospel let the Our Father be prayed with the sick person, and thereupon the words of the testament be spoken: Our Lord Jesus Christ [the words of institution follow] This do in remembrance of me. Upon these words let the body of the Lord under the bread be given to the sick person, saying thus: The body of our Lord Jesus Christ, given into death for thee, strengthen and preserve thee in the faith unto everlasting life. Amen. […] And upon such words let the blood of the Lord also be given to the sick person, saying thus: The blood of our dear Lord Jesus Christ, shed for thy sins, strengthen and preserve thee in right faith unto everlasting life. Amen. Thereafter let the hundred and eleventh psalm be said with the sick person: I will praise the Lord with my whole heart, in the assembly of the upright, and in the congregation. Or instead of the psalm a short psalm, or the Our Father. The Blessing. The Lord bless thee and keep thee. The Lord make his face shine upon thee, and be gracious unto thee. The Lord lift up his countenance upon thee, and give thee peace. Amen.

The later editions offer shorter psalms (Psalm 125 or 130) and add John 6. After the communion they add Psalms 91 and 117 "if he have repentance and devotion thereto".

Brandenburg-Nürnberg in 1533 had the minister hold the same order in church for a single person who could not wait for the Sunday communion: "with such a person one shall deal in the church even as one dealeth with a sick man in the house" (Sehling 11, p. 200). Veit Dietrich's Nuremberg *Agendbüchlein* (agenda booklet) of 1545 adds a chapter of "cases that befall touching the sacrament with the sick" (Sehling 11, pp. 520–521):

- the godless who will not confess their faith are to be left, "for our Lord Christ forbiddeth hard that one cast pearls before swine";
- the sacrament is never to be given in one kind; rather let the sick die without it;
- for one who cannot take wine, "some advise" a drop or two from the chalice in a drink of water, though such may also rely on the Word and spiritual eating;
- rough folk who have long stayed away are to be brought to repentance and then communicated "without delay";

- those in open vice who will not promise amendment are refused;
- those who cannot keep the sacrament down are to be comforted with the Word until they can;
- those already in their last throes or out of their minds are to be prayed for, but not given the sacrament.

The chapter ends with an exhortation not to save the sacrament for the last need, but to receive it in health.

13.8.4 The dying

Veit Dietrich 1545. When the end came, Dietrich told the minister not to shout long exhortations into the dying person's ears. He was to kneel, pray the Lord's Prayer aloud with those present, and close with a short collect commending the dying person, "since he was baptized in the name of Jesus". The candle was not to be put into the hand. A crucifix was permitted, but "the best crucifix" is the Word. **Nuremberg, *Agendbüchlein* of Veit Dietrich, 1545** (Sehling 11, p. 522):

In case the minister of the church be with the sick person and he now fall into the throes of death, it is no more needful to cry long and much into the ears of people who have been so instructed before, as is yet commonly done; but the minister shall kneel down and exhort others also to prayer. First pray an Our Father aloud and bid the others pray after him [...] The minister of the church or pastor shall also do away with candles and other things which were formerly used with the sick, that they be not given into the sick person's hands; for since this was done that they should thereby confess that they would die as Christians, we know that the one and right confession is this: when one acknowledgeth Christ Jesus as the only mediator and redeemer. [...] That one have a crucifix by the dying is not evil in itself. But whoso hath the comfort in the Word hath the best crucifix, which not only the eyes behold, but the ears grasp and the heart forms within itself.

13.8.5 Plague

Regensburg 1562. In plague time the orders laid the danger on one minister at a time. Regensburg's order of 1562 made the deacon "of the week" serve all the plague-sick in the pest house, the town and the countryside with the sacrament and God's Word. He was to keep away from church, baths and gatherings for that week, while the next deacon served the other sick, the baptisms and the rest. **Regensburg, *Ordnung für die Geistlichen zur Pestzeit*, 1562** (Sehling 13, p. 435):

Since firstly there are four deacons, he that is weekly minister shall be bound, until further provision of an honourable council, to provide with the most worthy sacrament and to comfort with God's word all those who are laden with the grievous sickness or pestilence in the pest house, in the town and in the council's territory. Yet he shall in every wise keep himself at home that same week, and not come among the commons into the churches, public baths or gatherings, but only wait upon the sick, as aforesaid.

Wittenberg, Halle and Torgau. Wittenberg's town order of 1533 likewise kept the fourth deacon for the plague-stricken villages "that the other three deacons bring not the pestilence among the people in the town" (Sehling 1, p. 702). The Halle church order (1573?) told the people to confess and receive the sacrament "with healthy body" in time of plague, so as to spare the minister the danger of infected houses (Sehling 2, p. 441). Torgau in 1575 bound every pastor to visit the plague-stricken "unless God should strike his own person" (Sehling 1, p. 683).

13.8.6 The condemned

Veit Dietrich 1545. The prisoner condemned to death was the pastor's charge from sentence to scaffold. Veit Dietrich's chapter "How one shall instruct and comfort prisoners condemned to death" was copied by Pfalz-Zweibrücken (1557), Regensburg (1567), Hohenlohe (1578) and others (Sehling 18, p. 28; 13, p. 484; 15, p. 290). It is a pastoral method in two parts:

- **"Terror".** Through the Ten Commandments the condemned is brought to know his sin against God, the magistrate and his neighbour.
- **"Comfort".** The first comfort is for the conscience: God's grace in sending him a minister rather than letting him die "in the fresh deed". The second is against "the shameful death" itself.

It begins with the question why the man lies captive. **Nuremberg, *Agendbüchlein* of Veit Dietrich, 1545** (Sehling 11, pp. 531–532):

How one shall instruct and comfort prisoners and those condemned to death. First of all one may ask them why they lie there captive. Then by the answer one will soon mark how it standeth with their heart. One will be silent, confess nothing, or begin to

excuse himself, how he came into it innocently, etc. Another will confess it, but yet with defiance. […] Another will confess it so that one must see by words and bearing that he is sore troubled, full of sorrow and misery. […] if he be timid and fearful, that one comfort him with God's goodness and mercy; if he be bold and defiant or impatient, that one rub the sin well into him and drive a terror into him, that he may know himself and learn to have repentance and sorrow over his misdeed.

Pfalz-Neuburg's general articles of 1576 add a chapter on "the instruction and comfort of prisoners condemned to death, and the burial of their bodies" (Sehling 13, p. 170). The Schwarzburg order of 1574 required that the ministers be told three or four days before an execution (Sehling 2, p. 135).

13.8.7 The possessed: prayer instead of exorcism

Pomerania 1569. The Pomeranian agenda of 1569 gives the only full evangelical rite for the possessed in the corpus. It forbids exorcism and "devil-banning" "as in the papacy", including the earnest exorcisms that some of "ours" have used. It orders that wandering sextons and others who pass themselves off as devil-banishers be examined by the superintendent and, if need be, punished by the secular arm. The pastor is first to warn the people against believing too readily in possession, "as is often alleged in sickness of the head, with the senseless and raving". Prayer is to be made in the neighbouring parishes. The visit itself runs thus:

1. Two or three ministers go together, having prepared themselves by prayer and fasting.
2. The greeting "The peace of our Lord Jesus Christ be in this house".
3. The Lord's Prayer with a few chosen Christians.
4. The sick man is reminded of his baptism and asked to say the creed and a confession of Christ. "If he can, he is not possessed."
5. If possession is not certain, the physicians are to be called.
6. If it is, there is to be no "pomp" of adjuration: Satan is resisted "with prayers and contempt".
7. A defiance of Satan, the laying of the hand on the sick man's head with the Lord's Prayer, a long prayer to Christ, and the Aaronic blessing in Trinitarian form.
8. On preaching days he is brought to a separate, guarded place in the church, and the congregation prays for him until God turns the need.

Pomerania, *Agenda*, 1569 (Sehling 4, pp. 461–462):

But when it is perceived that Satan by God's sufferance is present, for an example to us others and for a preaching of repentance, no pomp shall be undertaken with adjuring and the like: *but he is to be withstood with prayers and contempt of Satan, in the name of the Lord Jesus Christ*, that is, one shall despise the proud Satan and set oneself against him with prayer in the name of our Lord Jesus Christ […] Here let the priest lay his hand upon the sick man's head and say: Our Father, which art in heaven, etc.

The chapter ends: "More we cannot do. We must commend the need herewith to God, watch, pray, wait upon the Lord, and not grow weary" (Sehling 4, p. 463).

13.9 Funerals and burial

The evangelical funeral is the medieval funeral stripped of prayer for the dead. Gone are:

- the vigils (the office of the dead);
- the requiem Mass and the Masses of the seventh and thirtieth day and the anniversary (*Siebenter*, *Dreißigster*, *Jahrtag*);
- the sprinkling of holy water and the censing;
- the endowed "soul baths" and "soul gifts" (*Seelbad*, *Seelgerät*).

What remained was:

- the procession to the grave led by the schoolmaster and pupils;
- hymns of faith in the resurrection;
- a lesson or exhortation (usually 1 Thessalonians 4) and a collect;
- increasingly, a funeral sermon in the church.

The orders took great care over who might receive this "Christian burial". To refuse it was a sanction of church discipline.

Funeral sermons are treated in Chapter 11, §11.4.6, bells for the dead in Chapter 9, §9.5.6, and the vigils, the Office of the Dead, in Chapter 10, §10.9.

13.9.1 What was abolished

Vigils and soul-Masses. The Saxon visitors of 1528 ordered that "soul-Masses and other bought Masses shall no more be held" (Sehling 1, p. 164). The Ansbach diet of 1526 forbade anyone to be "compelled to hold any *Begängnis*, seventh or thirtieth day of a departed person" (Sehling 11, p. 90). Veit Dietrich's Nuremberg agenda opens its chapter on burial by abolishing "all papal pomp with holy water, singing over [the dead] and the rest". **Nuremberg, *Agendbüchlein* of Veit Dietrich, 1545** (Sehling 11, p. 528):

How one shall hold the burial. At the dead, when they are committed to the earth, all papal pomp with holy water, singing over [them] and the rest shall be done away; for all this hath been set up by the pope not only without God's word but also against God's word, as though it should further salvation. Now where there is a school, the scholars may sing the *Media vita* (In the midst of life), the *Nunc dimittis*, or another hymn in German or Latin, and the minister of the church or pastor may make this short exhortation, in these or other words, at the burial

Müntzer at Allstedt (Radical Reformation). Even the earliest German orders kept the procession and dropped the vigils. Thomas Müntzer described the Allstedt practice of about 1523–1524. The text stands at the foot of Sehling 1, p. 507, before the visitation order of 1533. The dead were fetched "with the Benedictus in German, without vigils", the people sang *Mitten in dem leben* (In the midst of life) after the burial, and in church 1 Thessalonians 4 and John 5 were read (Sehling 1, p. 507).

13.9.2 The Saxon burial, 1539–1540

Duke Henry's agenda gives the North German pattern.

1539. The 1539 text only prescribes the hymn of Simeon, *Mit fried und freud ich far dahin* (With peace and joy I depart), or *Mitten wir im leben sind* (In the midst of life we are) at the burial.

1540 and 1555. The editions of 1540 and 1555 expand it:

1. In towns the schoolmaster and pupils lead the body "honourably"; in the villages the pastor does.
2. A Latin responsory, such as *Si bona suscepimus* (If we have received good things).
3. German hymns with the people: *Aus tiefer not* (Out of deep distress), *Mitten wir im leben sind*, and at the grave the hymn of Simeon; "if there is time", *Wir gleuben all an einen gott* (We all believe in one God).
4. No sermon is required, but a priest present may close with a collect.

Saxony (Albertine), *Kirchenordnung*, 1539, texts of 1540 and 1555 (Sehling 1, p. 275):

Where there are scholars, let them first sing a Latin responsory, as *Si bona suscepimus*, etc. Thereafter let the people sing with them some German hymns, as *Aus tiefer not*, *Mitten wir im leben sind*, and at the grave the hymn of holy Simeon. In towns the bodies shall be honourably escorted by the schoolmaster and scholars, as occasion serveth, with the aforesaid hymns; likewise in the villages by the pastor, and with *Mit fried und freud* (With peace and joy I depart), etc.; item (if there be time) *Wir gleuben all an einen gott*, etc. It is not needful that a special sermon be made at the burial; but if a priest be present, he may conclude with this collect: Almighty God, who by the death of thy Son hast brought sin and death to nought, and by his resurrection hast restored innocence and everlasting life, that we, being delivered from the power of the devil, should by the power of the same resurrection have our mortal bodies also raised from the dead: grant us graciously that we may believe this steadfastly and with our whole heart, and obtain the joyful resurrection of our body with all the blessed, through the same thy Son Jesus Christ our Lord. Amen.

1580. Duke August's order of 1580 kept this text and added the funeral sermon. After the body has been carried to the churchyard with the ministers and people, and the people have gathered in the church, the minister reads one of the printed sermons that follow, or "if it be specially desired of him" preaches a fitting sermon of his own, and closes with a collect. Model *Leichpredigten* follow, the first on 1 Thessalonians 4 (Sehling 1, p. 371).

13.9.3 The Franconian burial: Brandenburg-Nürnberg 1533

The Franconian order gives the procession and the graveside exhortation. Where there are scholars and priests they sing:

- the Benedictus, or the "prayer of Moses", Psalm 90 (*Domine, refugium*);
- an antiphon such as *Media vita in morte sumus* (In the midst of life we are in death) or *Ego sum resurrectio et vita* (I am the resurrection and the life), or a German hymn.

Then an exhortation on 1 Thessalonians 4:13–18 is made, at the house or at the grave. **Brandenburg-Nürnberg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1533** (Sehling 11, p. 203):

Ye devout, dear brethren and sisters in the Lord: forasmuch as Almighty God hath called and taken N., our dear friend, brother and member of Christ, through death out of this wretched life in the right Christian faith (as we hope) to his eternal rest, and we are thereby moved to mourn, lament and bear sorrow; that we may bear ourselves as Christians therein, we will hear the comfortable words of holy Paul, who saith thus [...] Such exhortation may be made in the house whence the body is carried out, or at the grave, where most people are present.

The 1591 revision. The revision of 1591 allowed other texts and "funeral sermons and Christian hymns", and kept the Latin figural music for processional funerals "if specially desired". For "godless and epicurean people" who had not come to church or sacrament for years, or died in drunkenness or rage, it changed the hymns. *Mit fried und freud ich fahr dahin* (With peace and joy I depart) was not to be sung. Instead *Mitten wir im leben sind* (In the midst of life we are) was sung at the door, and penitential hymns on the way (Sehling 11, p. 202, apparatus).

13.9.4 Who received Christian burial

Regensburg 1560. Burial with hymns, bells and sermon was the church's testimony that the dead had died in the faith, and it could therefore be refused. Regensburg's council set out the principle. The funeral sermon and hymns are "not to be given to every one without distinction as an adiaphoron or worldly thing and friendship". They belong to those who confessed the true doctrine and used Word and sacrament, and not to despisers who died without repentance. These may still be "carried out honourably and laid in the common churchyard ... only the ceremonies that belong to Christianity excluded". Suicides are buried outside the churchyard by the executioner. **Regensburg, *Erklärung ... welchen ... leichpredig und leichgesänge nit mögen zugelassen werden*, 1560** (Sehling 13, p. 448):

Since the funeral sermon and the funeral hymns signify so much, that the church thereby acknowledgeth the departed for her member, beareth him witness thereby of a Christian life and death, and also layeth so much upon herself that she will stand with him at the same judgement before God upon the very faith which the departed confessed and showed in his life (so far as she knoweth or can know), therefore the said two, funeral sermon and funeral hymn, are not to be imparted to every one without distinction as an adiaphoron or worldly thing and friendship, but for God's, conscience's and Christian discipline's sake it is to be diligently weighed to whom they are to be imparted or not. [...] Since it hath always been held a peculiar, high sin and impenitence to slay oneself wilfully and knowingly, from whatever cause, it is accordingly also, after old custom, deemed right that such persons be not laid in the common churchyard, but be committed to the executioner or knacker to be buried or burned outside the churchyard, for a terror and example to others.

The same order makes allowance for those who die by accident, drowning or falling. These cases are to be judged one by one.

Mansfeld 1580. Mansfeld went further. Heretics, open despisers of the sacraments and those who died impenitent in open vice had always been refused "Christian burial and the customary ceremonies" there. They were not laid with other Christians nor "accompanied with bells or hymns". Pastors were to keep it so. **Mansfeld, *Kirchen-Agenda*, 1580** (Sehling 2, p. 246):

to such have hitherto in this county of Mansfeld, according to God's word and for sufficient causes, Christian burial and the customary ceremonies been refused and denied, so that they were not laid with other Christians, and were accompanied neither with ringing nor with hymns. By such custom it shall still be kept.

Children: Brandenburg-Ansbach 1594. Children were a particular case. The Ansbach consistory noted in 1594 that unbaptized children were not buried with other Christians. It noted too that baptized children under twelve who had not yet communicated were buried in some places with procession and scholars and in others "silently", "whereby Christian parents are not only made sore troubled, but oftentimes the mother, as the weaker vessel, falleth into great temptation". It then laid down a common order (Sehling 11, p. 392). At Soest the theologians' articles provided, as Sehling's editor summarizes them, that no funeral sermon be preached for children who had not yet gone to the Lord's Supper (Sehling 22, p. 380).

13.10 Ordination

The evangelical ordination is a public rite of the church. It confirms a man already examined and called to the office of preaching and the sacraments. It has three parts:

- the prayer of the congregation;
- the reading of 1 Timothy 3 and Acts 20 with the ordinand's promise;
- the laying on of hands by the ordinator and the other ministers, with the Lord's Prayer and a prayer for the Holy Spirit.

What was dropped. It drops the vesting, the anointing of the hands and the delivery of chalice and paten, the parts of the medieval rite that conferred the power to offer sacrifice. The Merseburg draft of 1545 names them, "the putting on of the garments, and unction etc.", as "needless, abusive ceremonies, which did nothing for the ordination" (Sehling 2, p. 6). How far the evangelical diaconate was also conferred by ordination is treated in Chapter 16 §§16.5 and 16.8.

Where it was done. The orders differ in this:

- **Centrally.** In Saxony ordination was done at Wittenberg or Leipzig before the candidate went to his parish.
- **In the parish.** In Hesse, Lippe and many later orders it was done in the candidate's own parish by the superintendent, joined with his installation (§13.11).

The vows taken at ordination are treated in Chapter 17, §17.4, and the examination and trial sermon before it in Chapter 15, §15.7.3.

13.10.1 Why the evangelicals ordained

The *Wittenberg Reformation* of 1545. The first Wittenberg ordination was held in 1535. Ordination had belonged to the bishops, but they had "long persecuted the divine truth". It could not be sought from them while they required an oath to false doctrine. The *Wittenberg Reformation* of 1545 nevertheless kept the door open: if the bishops would accept right doctrine and appoint able examiners, "they could do much good". **Electoral Saxony, *Wittenbergische Reformation*, 1545** (Sehling 1, p. 211):

yet are the rulers bound to do their part thereto, that men may have preachers and priests, and that the same be ordained, examined, accepted or rejected at certain places by learned and God-fearing men. This work hath been committed to the bishops. Now they have for a long time persecuted the divine truth, and let the churches in their own territories stand empty and become waste and heathen. […] For where they remain persecutors of Christian doctrine, and will not ordain without an obligation to false doctrine and to the persecution of the truth, ordination cannot be sought from them.

Albertine Saxony 1557. The Albertine general articles of 1557 fixed the places: "The ordination of priests shall be undertaken at Leipzig and Wittenberg, and be done and held in all wise as it hath been customary at those places from the time of the pure evangelical doctrine". The candidate was to be examined in doctrine, asked where he had studied and how he had lived, and made to preach publicly once or more (Sehling 1, p. 322).

13.10.2 The Wittenberg form, 1537–1539

Sources. Sehling prints Luther's *Forma der Ordination* (Form of ordination) of 1537 in what Rietschel held to be its oldest form. His apparatus gives Bugenhagen's expanded Wittenberg text of 1539 and the form Melanchthon gave to two Kulmbach preachers in 1538. After it comes the Latin form "used when foreigners come to seek ordination who do not understand German". Sehling's headnote traces the form into the Braunschweig-Wolfenbüttel order of 1543, Hildesheim, Mecklenburg 1552 and Sarcerius's Mansfeld *Ordinatien form* (Sehling 1, pp. 24–26).

The rite is in seven parts:

1. **Prayer before.** After the examination, the congregation is asked in the sermon to pray for the ordinands and the whole ministry.
2. **The hymn.** All kneel before the altar, the ordinator and the presbyters with the ordinands, and the choir sings *Veni sancte spiritus* with the versicle *Cor mundum crea in me, Deus* (Create in me a clean heart, O God) and the collect of the Holy Spirit.
3. **The lessons.** The ordinator goes up the altar step and reads 1 Timothy 3:1–7 and Acts 20:28–31.

4. **The charge and promise.** He addresses the ordinands: they are not set to keep "geese or cows" but the church bought with God's blood, to feed it with the pure Word, guard it against wolves and sects, and live honestly with their households. Then he asks "Are ye now ready to do this?". They answer "Yes".
5. **The laying on of hands.** With the hands of the ordinator and all the presbyters on the ordinands' heads, the Lord's Prayer is said aloud, then the prayer "Merciful God, heavenly Father … the harvest is great".
6. **The sending.** 1 Peter 5:2–4: "Go ye now therefore and feed the flock of Christ". In Bugenhagen's text the ordinator then blesses them with the sign of the cross: "Benedicat vobis dominus, ut faciatis fructum multum" (The Lord bless you, that ye may bring forth much fruit).
7. ***Nu bitten wir den heiligen geist*** (Now pray we the Holy Ghost) is sung, the Mass follows, and the newly ordained commune first.

The Latin form gives the charge, the question, the laying on of hands and the prayer in one continuous text. **Luther, *Forma ordinationis latina*, 1539** (Sehling 1, p. 28):

That ye will do these things to the utmost of your power, promise here in public with a clear voice: Say, I promise. Lay on hands. Let us pray with joined prayers. Our Father, which art in heaven. […] Most merciful God, eternal Father of our Lord Jesus Christ, who by the mouth of thy beloved Son our Lord Jesus Christ hast said unto us, "The harvest truly is plenteous, but the labourers are few. Pray ye therefore the Lord of the harvest, that he send forth labourers into his harvest": obeying this thy divine command, we pray with our whole heart that thou wouldest vouchsafe graciously to bestow thy Holy Spirit upon these who seek from this church the confirmation of their calling, and upon us, and upon all that are called to the ministry of thy word, whereby we may be, joined in great number, faithful and steadfast ministers of thy gospel, fortified and strengthened by thy help and defence against the devil, the world and the flesh, that through us, though unworthy and weak, thy name may yet be hallowed, thy kingdom increased, and some things be done well-pleasing to thee and saving to many. […] Now therefore, going forth according to the precept of the apostle Peter, feed the flock of Christ which is committed to you […] The Lord bless you, that ye may bring forth much fruit. Amen.

The ordinands are said to seek "the confirmation of their calling" from the church. The call comes first, through the congregation and magistrate. Ordination confirms it publicly with prayer.

13.10.3 Ordination within the Mass: Merseburg 1545

The draft. When Luther was at Merseburg in 1545, Prince Georg of Anhalt, administrator of the see in spiritual things, drafted the order for the first evangelical ordination there. Sehling summarizes it from the Zerbst manuscript:

1. A sermon explaining ordination and the laying on of hands, and why the vesting and the unction were dropped.
2. A sung Latin Mass: *Veni sancte spiritus*, the introit *Benedicta sit sancta trinitas* (Blessed be the holy Trinity), Kyrie and Gloria.
3. A German collect for the ordinands, and the epistle Ephesians 4:7.
4. The *scrutinium*: questions on faith, on heresies, and on life and office.
5. The Alleluia, the Gospel John 20, the Creed, and the *Veni creator* (Come, Creator) while ordinator and ordinands kneel.
6. 1 Timothy 3 and John 20 read.
7. The commission of "the ministry of the word and the administration of the sacraments, the use of the keys … and authority to ordain others".
8. The laying on of hands by the ordinator and all the priests in turn, with Luther's prayer *Barmherziger gott* (Merciful God).
9. 1 Peter 5, and the blessing with the sign of the cross, received kneeling.
10. The preface, Sanctus, Lord's Prayer and consecration "in the usual manner".
11. The communion of the ordained, with *Ite in orbem* (Go ye into the world) or *Jesus Christus unser heiland* (Jesus Christ our Saviour).
12. The *Te Deum* (We praise thee, O God).

Merseburg, Georg of Anhalt's draft *Ordinations-Ordnung*, 1545, as summarized by Sehling (Sehling 2, p. 7):

The ordinator readeth the text 1 Timothy 3:1, and if it please, the saying John 20: And Jesus said unto his disciples, Peace be unto you, etc. "Hereupon let the ordinator commit the ministry of the word and the administration of the sacraments, the use of the keys (also, if it please) the authority to ordain others, expressly, for the sake of the bystanders." (Laying on of hands by the ordinator and all the priests in turn.)

Georg as bishop. Sehling adds that Georg "had himself consecrated bishop on 2 August 1545, and thereafter performed the ordinations in person; in all he ordained 81 preachers" (Sehling 2, p. 8). This, with the ordination by Bugenhagen of Tilemann von Hussen as the first evangelical bishop of Schleswig in May 1542 (Sehling 23, p. 300), is the corpus's evidence for the consecration of evangelical bishops. The orders print no form for it.

13.10.4 Regensburg 1553: the Spirit as the "true priestly ordination and unction"

The Regensburg *Form der Ordination oder Priesterweihe* (Form of ordination or priestly consecration), probably by Nikolaus Gallus, opens with the *Veni sancte spiritus* and a defence of the right to ordain. The power of the keys, and with it the power to call and ordain ministers, belongs to the true church. Within the church, "for the sake of order", it is exercised by the ministers. The defence ends with a declaration of what ordination gives. **Regensburg, *Form der Ordination oder Priesterweihe*, 1553?** (Sehling 13, p. 429):

But we hold ordination according to apostolic use with the laying on of the hands of the priesthood and common prayer, and believe that thereby the Holy Ghost is given unto the office, that he will be mighty through the same, as Christ saith: Receive ye the Holy Ghost, etc.; which Spirit is the true priestly ordination and unction, which hath sure witness of Scripture and is given to preach God's word and to administer the sacraments, not to offer for the living and the dead, whereof the Scripture knoweth nothing.

The rest of the rite follows this order:

1. **Prayer and lessons.** The Lord's Prayer, then 1 Timothy 3 and Acts 20 with a short exposition.
2. **The vow.** The ordinand vows "in place of an oath" to preach purely according to the prophets, the apostles and the Augsburg Confession, to administer the sacraments as Christ instituted them, and to adhere to no false doctrine: "I, N., vow hereby publicly before God and his congregation that I will faithfully keep all this. So help me God".
3. **The commission**, with the laying on of hands by all the ministers.
4. **A prayer and the blessing** "Go and bring forth much fruit".

Regensburg, *Form der Ordination oder Priesterweihe*, 1553? (Sehling 13, pp. 430–431):

Then all the ministers lay on their hands, and the office is committed to him in this wise: Forasmuch then as thou hast vowed this, and Christ hath commanded his church to send ministers of the word, even as the Father sent him and he his dear apostles, so we give thee now, by virtue of the same commandment, power hereby to preach the gospel and to administer the sacraments, as he saith: Teach them to observe all things whatsoever I have commanded you, in the name of the Father and of the Son and of the Holy Ghost. Amen.

13.10.5 Ordination in the parish: Hesse 1574 and the Palatinate 1592

Hesse 1574 (Philippist). The Hessian agenda of 1574 joins ordination to the first installation of a pastor in his own church. Two or three neighbouring pastors attend as witnesses. The rite runs:

1. A sermon of half to three-quarters of an hour on the office of preacher and hearers.
2. *Kom heiliger Geist* (Come, Holy Ghost), the superintendent and pastors facing the people and the ordinand facing the superintendent.
3. An address on the vacancy and the lawful call.
4. A long reading on the pastor's office: Matthew 28, Titus 1, 2 Timothy 3–4 and others.
5. A list of the pastor's duties, and the ordinand's vow.
6. The laying on of hands, kneeling at the altar, with the formula below.
7. A prayer, and the commendation of the church to the new pastor and of the pastor to the people.

Hesse, *Agende*, 1574 (Philippist; Sehling 8, pp. 454–455):

After this prayer hands shall be laid upon the ordinand, who remaineth kneeling before the altar, and the superintendent or his substitute shall say thus: So I now ordain and confirm you, on behalf of the church of God, upon your promise made, as an ordinary minister of the church and teacher of the holy gospel, in the name of God the Father and of the Son and of the Holy Ghost. Amen.

Sehling's editor notes that these words are new against the Hessian (Moderate Reformed) tradition of 1539 and 1566 (Sehling 8, p. 454, n. 55).

The Palatinate 1592. The Reformed Palatinate used a *Heidelbergische forma ordinationis*. It read 1 Timothy 3 and 4 and Titus 1 and prayed for the Spirit. Then, with the laying on of hands, came a formula close to the Saxon investiture of 1580 (§13.11). **Kurpfalz, *Ordnung der Ordination*, 1592** (Reformed; Sehling 19/2, p. 792):

Now since we are gathered in the name of God and have together called upon God our heavenly Father through Jesus Christ and prayed, and doubt not that he hath graciously heard and granted us according to his divine promise, I, as an ordinary minister of the congregation of God, ordain, confirm and establish you herewith to the office of preaching, and now to be a minister and pastor of the Christian congregation at N., with earnest charge that ye preside over the congregation of God without offence, diligently and faithfully, as ye are bound before God, in the name of the Father and of the Son and of the Holy Ghost. Amen. *Let the hand be laid on.*

Other forms. Other orders with their own ordination forms include:

- Pomerania's agenda of 1569, whose first chapter is "How priests shall be ordained in Christian wise to the holy office of preaching" (Sehling 4, p. 421);
- Marbach's Strasbourg order of 1553, where pastors and helpers are examined in the clergy convent and then "confirmed and ordained with laying on of hands and prayer" before the whole congregation on the following Sunday (Sehling 20/1, p. 424);
- the Lippe order of 1571 (Sehling 21, p. 436);
- the Schaumburg order of 1614, which follows "the reading, prayer and laying on of hands" of Luther's form (Sehling 7/2.2, p. 140).

13.11 Installation of pastors, superintendents, abbots and bishops

Ordination happened once, but every move to a new cure needed a public installation. The orders call it variously:

- *Investitur* (investiture);
- *Einweisung* (induction);
- *Präsentation* (presentation);
- *commendiren, einleiben und installiren* (commending, incorporating and installing).

The superintendent, or a neighbouring pastor in his name, came with the patron's or prince's officer. He preached on the ministry, prayed over the new minister and commended the people to him and him to the people. Where the candidate was newly called, ordination and installation were often one act (§13.10.5). The same pattern served for superintendents and, in Württemberg, for the evangelical abbots of the monastery schools. For evangelical bishops the orders say only that they were ordained "with prayer and the laying on of hands", like other ministers.

13.11.1 The Saxon investiture, 1580

The form and its spread. The most widely used form was printed in the Braunschweig-Wolfenbüttel order of 1569 under the heading "In what wise a new minister of the church shall be commended, incorporated and installed by the superintendents in his church". Sehling's editors note it at Oldenburg 1573 (Sehling 7/2.1, p. 1127, n. 2). The same text stands in:

- Lippe 1571 (Sehling 21, p. 438);
- Pfalz-Neuburg 1576 (Sehling 13, p. 173);
- Duke August's Saxon order of 1580, where it is joined to ordination (Sehling 1, p. 382).

The rite. The superintendent or his adjunct comes "with the officer, the collator or the lord of the place, together with a neighbouring pastor as witnesses of the act". The rite then runs:

1. *Nun bitten wir den heiligen geist* (Now pray we the Holy Ghost) or *Kom heiliger geist* (Come, Holy Ghost).
2. A sermon on the ministry of the Word, urging the people to love God's Word and honour its ministers.
3. The Creed sung, during which the superintendent goes to the altar and has the new pastor or deacon kneel.
4. A short address on the lawful choice and call.

5. A collect for the preservation of the ministry, John 20:21–23, 1 Timothy 3:1–7 and Acts 20:28–31.
6. A second prayer, or Luther's ordination prayer "Barmherziger gott" (Merciful God).
7. The Lord's Prayer, said or sung.
8. The laying on of the right hand on the bare head, with the formula below.
9. The *Te Deum* (We praise thee, O God) or another hymn.

Saxony, *Ordnung* of Duke August, 1580 (Sehling 1, p. 383):

After the prayer or the singing of the Our Father, the superintendent shall turn before the altar toward the people, and, as is customary (according to the Christian liberty given by the Lord Christ to the church in outward, indifferent ceremonies), lay his right hand upon the bare head of the new pastor or deacon, and say thus: Forasmuch as we, gathered in the Holy Ghost, have called upon God our heavenly Father through Jesus Christ our Lord and Saviour over thee and prayed, and therefore doubt not that he will have graciously heard and granted us according to his divine promise: therefore I ordain, confirm and establish thee, by divine command and ordinance, to be a minister and pastor of this congregation, with earnest charge that thou preside over it in true fear of God honourably, without any offence, with the utmost diligence and faithfulness, as becometh a faithful shepherd of the sheep of Christ, and as thou must stand before the judgement seat of our Lord Jesus Christ on that day to answer therefor to the earnest and righteous Judge, and await his sentence: in the name of the Father, and of the Son, and of the Holy Ghost. Amen.

Where it was done. In the Reuss lordships the newly ordained were "inducted, invested, presented and commended to the people" by the superintendent of each place (Sehling 2, p. 155). In Brandenburg the visitors recorded that a town's pastor, called by the council, had been "confirmed and solemnly invested by the superintendent" at the visitation (Sehling 3, p. 183). Baden in 1556 distinguished two cases (Sehling 16, p. 526):

- a man new to the ministry was "installed by the superintendent before the whole congregation";
- one already in the ministry was only "commended to the church with the ordinary prayer".

13.11.2 Presentation in the Reformed Palatinate, 1592

The Palatine *Forma praesentationis* (Form of presentation) of 1592 (Reformed) puts four questions to the new minister before the congregation, after the sermon and at the place of the Lord's Supper, with the officer present. **Kurpfalz, *Ordnung der Einführung der Kirchendiener*, 1592** (Reformed; Sehling 19/2, p. 793):

First, whether he feeleth in his heart the witness of the Holy Ghost, that he desireth so high a service not for his own profit or honour, but only for the honour of God and the edification of his Christian church? Secondly, whether he be resolved, without all falsehood and hypocrisy, to proclaim and expound the prophetic and apostolic Scriptures, as the only immovable foundation of our salvation, to the hearers committed to him, with the utmost diligence and faithfulness, publicly and privately according to each one's need and occasion? Thirdly, whether he will also administer and dispense the holy and most worthy sacraments of our Lord Jesus Christ according to his institution and ordinance, without any human trifling and addition? […] Fourthly, whether he will, by God's grace, so live and walk for himself and his household that his hearers may have no offence in him, but be bettered?

After his "express yes" to each, he is "presented to the church" with a prayer to Christ "who alone awakeneth, calleth and maketh fit such ministers". The same questions, adapted, were put to the lay elders at their installation (see Chapter 16 §16.6.3).

13.11.3 The evangelical abbots of Württemberg

An installation in place of an abbatial blessing. Württemberg kept its great monasteries as schools for future ministers, with evangelical "prelates" as their abbots. An order of about 1556 for "the presentation and investiture of new prelates" replaced the abbatial blessing with a civil oath and an evangelical installation:

1. **The oath.** On the morning of the installation the new abbot's obligation is read to him by the secretary of the church council. He takes the oath with three fingers of his right hand laid in the Gospel of John.
2. **In the church.** He is led to the abbot's stall. The schoolboys sing German psalms, the Creed or the Lord's Prayer. The provost or a theologian preaches on the ministry and on the true use of monasteries.
3. **The investiture.** *Kom heiliger Geist* (Come, Holy Ghost) is sung. Before the altar the new prelate kneels and is "invested or installed according to the agenda", which is the Württemberg order of 1553. The act ends with "a fine hymn or motet and

the blessing".

4. **The presentation.** He is then presented to the school, where the eldest preceptor gives a Latin oration and the pupils give their handfast promise of obedience. Next he is presented to the officials and household of the monastery, and to its subjects, who also give their hands.
5. **The meal.** A breakfast follows, to which the neighbouring pastors are invited.

Württemberg, *Investiturordnung für evangelische Prälaten*, after 1556 (Sehling 16, pp. 321–322):

His obligation or bond, drawn up beforehand in the usual common form and engrossed on parchment, is read to him by the secretary of the church council, and thereafter the Bible or New Testament is held before him by the provost or the theologian appointed to the act in his absence, into which he layeth three fingers of his right hand in the Gospel of John [...] When now the sermon is ended, *Kum heiliger Geist* (Come, Holy Ghost) is sung in German, and the provost or the appointed theologian goeth before the altar, to which the Lord Steward and the director, or two of the appointed commissioners, lead the new prelate, who kneeleth down before the altar and is duly invested or installed according to the agenda, and it is concluded at last with a fine hymn or motet and the blessing.

13.11.4 Bishops and superintendents

No consecration rite. No order in the corpus prints a rite for consecrating a bishop. The evangelical bishops of Schleswig, Samland and Pomesania, and Merseburg under Georg of Anhalt, were ordained like other ministers.

Schleswig-Holstein 1542. The Schleswig-Holstein order of 1542 makes the ceremonies for bishop and presbyter the same: prayer from the pulpit, a lesson, and prayer with the laying on of hands. The first evangelical bishop, Tilemann von Hussen, was ordained in Schleswig cathedral by Bugenhagen in May 1542 (Sehling 23, pp. 120, 300). **Schleswig-Holstein, *Kirchenordnung*, 1542** (Sehling 23, p. 120):

When he visiteth, he may ordain priests that are chosen and sent to him, wherever he will; otherwise he shall ordain at Schleswig in his church. But how and with what ceremonies the *ordinatio Episcopi et Presbyterii* (ordination of bishop and presbytery) shall be done, namely with prayer going before from the pulpit, with a lesson out of the Holy Scripture, with prayer and laying on of hands, as the holy apostles have done, all this shall be set in a special book.

Prussia 1568. The Prussian order of 1568 regulated the election of the bishops of Samland and Pomesania. They were to be chosen "with the good counsel of the bishop then living, of all the princely court and land councillors", with eight deputies of the nobility and eight of the towns and other learned ministers. It confirmed their "spiritual government and full jurisdiction" (Sehling 4, p. 107).

Superintendents. The orders give no separate liturgy for installing a superintendent beyond the investiture of §13.11.1. Sehling's introductions record such installations only as events: Jacob Runge, for instance, "was installed into the office of general superintendent of Pomerania-Wolgast" on 7 March 1557 (Sehling 4, p. 323).

13.12 Minor orders, lay offices, church workers and religious communities

13.12.1 The minor orders and the lay offices of the congregation

No conferral of minor orders. The evangelical orders did not confer the minor orders (porter, lector, exorcist, acolyte) or the subdiaconate. Their functions passed to sextons, schoolmasters, schoolboys and the deacons of the poor. The full evidence, with the installation of each office, is set out in Chapter 16 §§16.3 and 16.8. In brief:

- **Laying on of hands** was used, besides ministers of the Word, only:
  - for deacons of the poor in Hesse 1566 (Moderate Reformed) and the London strangers' church (Reformed);
  - for lay elders in Hesse 1566 (Moderate Reformed), the London church and the Palatinate (1592) (both Reformed);
  - for the Bohemian Brethren's clerical deacons.
- **Prayer, a handfast vow or an oath** installed:
  - Reformed elders elsewhere (Kurpfalz about 1601, Hanau 1609, Solms), and the elders of Lutheran Veldenz;
  - Lutheran deacons of the poor in Pomerania;
  - churchwardens.

- **Nothing** is described for the Bohemian acolytes, Lutheran almoners and most churchwardens beyond appointment.

Three full forms. Three forms in the corpus install elders and deacons with prayer and the laying on of hands, as a true ordination to a lay office. They are given here in full.

Hesse 1566: elders (Moderate Reformed). The Hessian order of 1566 has the elders chosen in each church by its ministers with members of the council and congregation, by vote (Acts 14:23). They are examined on their willingness and then "ordained" in their own church by the superintendent at visitation, or by a pastor with one or two other ministers. The rite runs:

1. A short address, as at the ordination of pastors.
2. The lesson Acts 20:28–31 ("Take heed therefore unto yourselves, and to all the flock").
3. A charge expounding the elders' office in five points:
    - to guard with the ministers against false doctrine and to see that the sacraments are rightly given;
    - to keep the ministers in unity and the congregation free of hatred and schism;
    - to admonish negligent ministers;
    - to exercise the church's judgement: to rebuke the fallen, put the obstinate in the ban, and loose the penitent;
    - to help the ministers in answering questions, reconciling enemies and relieving the poor.
4. The question: will they do all this "before the face of God and of our Lord Jesus Christ and all the elect angels, with the whole congregation here present"? Each answers in turn, as the pastors do at ordination.
5. The people kneel, and the pastor prays.
6. The pastor and the other ministers lay on hands.
7. The charge, "We commit unto you this church".
8. An exhortation to the congregation to receive them with goodwill.
9. Psalm 23, *Der Herr ist mein Hirte* (The Lord is my shepherd); the blessing; the names entered in the church book.

Hesse, *Kirchenordnung*, 1566 (Moderate Reformed; Sehling 8, p. 209):

Then shall the pastor briefly exhort every one to prayer, and when they have kneeled down, pray before them thus: Almighty, everlasting God, heavenly Father, forasmuch as thy beloved Son, our Lord and high priest Jesus Christ, hath promised that he will abide with us alway unto the end of the world, and hath nevertheless given unto men divers gifts, and among these also helps, assistance and authority rightly to order and maintain the churches: we beseech thee humbly that thou wouldest endue, teach and sanctify the hearts of these thy servants with thy Holy Spirit, that they, being at all times furnished with wisdom and wholesome counsel, may gladly and heartily govern this thy church faithfully and steadfastly, together with the pastors and elders which labour in the word; that the spiritual fruit may be perceived in all the faithful fully and abundantly; through the same thy Son Christ our Lord, etc. Whereupon they all answer: Amen. Thereafter the pastor and the other ministers shall lay their hands upon them, as was said before, etc. After all this the ordinands shall be set in the midst, and the church shall be committed unto them to care for and to govern with such words as these: We commit unto you this church, in which ye have been chosen elders, that ye govern well and keep in health the flock of the Lord which he hath redeemed with his blood and which the Holy Ghost hath entrusted unto you; and that ye may perform all this, be circumspect, take diligent heed to all that befalleth, be helpful to the ministers of the word in all things. When they take counsel, deal wisely and uprightly; in admonitions be modest; in rebuking be ever mindful of love. When ye judge or give sentence, lay aside all human affection; all that ye or others bring forward, handle it according to the rule of the divine word. Let nothing lie more heavily upon you than the honour of God and the edification of the faithful.

Hesse 1566: deacons (Moderate Reformed). The deacons of the poor are chosen by the preachers or elders with members of the council and congregation, at least two in each church, and put on probation (1 Timothy 3:10). At their ordination the minister reads them a charge in three points: to show that they have the Holy Ghost by seeking only God's honour; to live honourably and rule their households; and to gather the alms, rents and dues with care, keep them in a register, pay the ministers' wages, relieve the poor in due time, and keep the church fabric in repair. The charge ends with the vow. The laying on of hands follows "with common prayer", on the apostles' example in Acts 6 (Sehling 8, pp. 207–208). **Hesse, *Kirchenordnung*, 1566** (Moderate Reformed; Sehling 8, p. 211):

Ye shall also be ever mindful that ye are servants not of men only but of God also, and must therefore give account of your office not to men only but also to God the Lord, who is not deceived. These are the chief duties of the deacons in the congregation of God, which are shewn in the holy Scripture. Therefore I now desire of you, before the face of God and of his holy angels, that ye will vow and promise to keep all this faithfully.

Hesse 1566: sextons (Moderate Reformed). The same order has the sextons (*Opfermänner*, *aeditui*, *custodes*) taken on by the pastor and elders with the superintendent's knowledge, with no rite (Sehling 8, p. 211).

Micron's London order: elders (Reformed). The Dutch stranger church in London installed both elders and deacons by a public "confirmation" (*bestetigung*) with laying on of hands. Its *Ordinancien* (1554) are printed by Sehling in the East Frisian German edition of 1565. The elders' rite, in chapter 6, runs:

1. After the sermon the elders are set before the congregation. The minister reports from the pulpit that their election was lawful and no hindrance was found.
2. Three questions:
    - Do they feel the witness of the Holy Ghost that they take the office for God's honour and not their own?
    - Do they believe that the prophetic and apostolic doctrine contains all that is needful to salvation?
    - Will they support the ministers, edify the congregation by their life, and submit to Christian discipline if they offend?
3. A prayer to Christ and the Lord's Prayer.
4. The laying on of hands by "the other ministers and the minister of the word", with the blessing quoted below under the Palatinate.
5. Exhortations to the congregation (to pray for the elders) and to the elders (to fear no man, watch over the ministers' doctrine and life, and guard the flock from wolves).
6. A psalm and the dismissal.

Micron, *Ordinancien* (1554), East Frisian German edition, 1565 (Reformed; Sehling 7/1, p. 596):

Lord Jesus Christ, thou Son of the living God, who wilt govern thy congregation here on earth unto the end of the world by the service of men orderly called thereto: we beseech thee humbly that thou wouldest so enlighten these men, our brethren (who are chosen to the service of the government of this thy congregation), with the gifts of thy Holy Spirit, that they may walk faithfully in their calling and carry it on uprightly unto the end of their life, to the honour of thee and of thy heavenly Father, whom we humbly call upon through thy name, as we are taught of thee, saying: Our Father, which art in heaven, etc.

Micron's London order: deacons. The deacons' rite, in chapter 7, follows the same pattern "exactly", as the editor notes. The four questions add a vow to gather and distribute the alms "without any respect of persons". The prayer asks Christ, who has commended the poor to us, to "root out all roots of covetousness" and give these men his Spirit "as thou didst of old to Stephen". After the laying on of hands the minister exhorts the rich to give, the whole congregation to sobriety and labour, and the poor to pray for the rich. **Micron, *Ordinancien* (1554), East Frisian German edition, 1565** (Reformed; Sehling 7/1, pp. 597–598):

Lord Jesus Christ, who hast expressly commended thyself unto us in our poor, and our poor in thyself, that a special care should be had of them in thy congregation, whereunto deacons were ordained by thine apostles: we beseech thee humbly that thou wouldest root out of our hearts all roots of covetousness, and give unto these men thy Spirit, as thou didst of old impart it abundantly to Stephen thy first martyr, who was ordained to this service; that they may serve thy poor among us godly and faithfully in true love, without any respect of persons or motion of their affections [...] When the prayer is ended, hands are laid upon them, and the minister saith with a clear voice thus: God the Lord and our heavenly Father, who hath called you to the service of the diaconate, govern you graciously with his divine power, wisdom and goodness, that ye may walk worthily in him, to his honour and the edification of his congregation, for the sake of his only-begotten Son Jesus Christ our Lord. Amen.

The Palatinate 1592: elders (Reformed). The Palatine form of 9 December 1592 for installing the elders "who labour not in the word" is Micron's elders' rite almost word for word: the same report from the pulpit, the same three questions, the same prayer, laying on of hands, exhortations and psalm. No Palatine form for deacons is printed. **Kurpfalz, *Einführung der Senioren*, 9 December 1592** (Reformed; Sehling 19/2, pp. 789–790):

Thereafter hands are laid upon them by the other ministers and by the minister of the word, who saith with a clear voice thus: God our heavenly Father, who hath called and set you apart with us to the government of this his congregation (according to the doctrine of his word), enlighten you also by his Holy Spirit and strengthen you with the power of his invincible hand, that ye may fulfil your service faithfully and steadfastly to the honour of his name and the edification of his congregation. Amen.

13.12.2 Sextons

The sexton (*Küster*, *Opfermann*, *Mesner*, *Sigrist*, *Glöckner*) was chosen with the pastor's and the officer's knowledge and examined in reading, writing, singing and the catechism. He then bound himself to the pastor and parish by a pledge rather than with a rite. The Lippe order of 1571 gives the pledge in full:

- reverence and obedience to the pastor;
- an honest life "as an example to the flock";
- learning and leading the hymns of the feasts;
- opening and locking the church;
- keeping the font filled with clean water;
- keeping church, ornaments and churchyard clean.

It adds a warning against sextons who still dealt in "godless devil's blessings or charms" or wrote out "St John's Gospel" as an amulet. **Lippe, *Kirchenordnung*, 1571** (Sehling 21, p. 447):

After such exploration or inquiry the sexton that is accepted shall oblige or bind himself to the pastor and parishioners in manner as followeth: that he be found willing and ready toward his pastor in all Christian services belonging to his office, without displeasure, murmuring or delay; item, that he will show and prove to him due reverence and respect; also lead a modest, honourable and retired life and conversation with the pastor, as an example to the flock; likewise, that he also diligently learn the fine spiritual songs and wholesome, profitable psalms of the chief feasts and holy days, and sing them before the people with right devotion [...] Besides this, the sexton shall also open and lock the church at the right and customary time, often fill the font with clean, fresh water, and keep and preserve the church and its ornaments, and the churchyards also, cleanly, neatly and, as is meet and fitting, seemly.

Heidelberg 1572: the bell-ringer's appointment and pledge (Reformed). In the Palatinate the sexton's place was filled by a written appointment (*Bestallung*), to which the appointee answered with a signed pledge (*Revers*). The bell-ringer of the collegiate church of the Holy Ghost at Heidelberg, Philipp Reysing, was appointed on 15 May 1572 by the steward of the church's property. His articles bound him:

1. to take his orders from the ministers, serve the sick as told, and help hear the children in the catechism;
2. to ring for every sermon and stay in church during it, keeping order;
3. to keep the cloths, silver and vessels for the Supper and baptism, received by inventory;
4. to clear out the chests and lumber that hucksters put in the church, and keep the doors clear;
5. to drive out "the wicked boys and other rabble" who soil the pews between sermons;
6. to set up and take down the candles and lanterns, and in plague time and damp weather to fumigate the church with burning juniper;
7. to grease and keep the bells, above all the two great bells and the two choir bells;
8. to keep the royal, electoral and princely tombs clean and locked, and open them only in his own presence.

His wages were 16 florins 15 albus and money for six pounds of hellers from the foundation, three albus for every funeral he rang, three for every wedding, four pence for every baptism in the church, two pence from every house at Christmas, and a house or eight florins' rent. The Bestallung was renewed for his successor Hans Geyer in 1577. **Heidelberg, *Bestallung eines Glöckners*, 15 May 1572** (Reformed; Sehling 14, p. 457):

He shall take good care and heed to all the bells, and specially to the two greatest, together with the two choir bells, which the foundation is bound to maintain, and shall grease them every month and keep them in good condition. He shall keep the royal, electoral and princely tombs within and without the choir clean and neat, and also well locked, that they be not defaced by idle rabble. [...] This he hath so accepted and promised to perform faithfully and with his best diligence, in witness of this appointment delivered unto him [...] Therefore I confess that I have so accepted, and vow herewith in good faith to attend upon this my service, so long as I shall continue therein, with all possible diligence according to my ability, and faithfully to live by and perform what my appointment containeth, and what else is commanded me on the church's behalf.

The sexton as sacristan. No order has a separate sacristan; the sexton kept the vessels, vestments, font and lights (see Chapter 16 §16.7.1). His installation therefore took the same forms:

- **A yearly appointment: Anhalt 1594** (Philippist). The village of Törten petitioned for a sexton of its own who could keep school and read in church in the pastor's absence. It agreed a levy for his wages, and the superintendent and the district officer advised on the matter. The prince's court councillors then summoned the whole community and, "with the consent

and obligation of them all in common and of each in particular", set down the sexton's office and wages in a written decree. The office itself was granted "for one year only", and the sexton had to sue for it anew with the pastor before every Michaelmas (Sehling 2, pp. 579–580).

- **Surety for the vessels: Sayn 1590.** Because the chalices and ornaments were entrusted to him, no bell-ringer was to be received unless he was "well known" or gave a warrantor or surety (Sehling 19/1, p. 438).
- **Appointment by the parish: Strasbourg 1531** (Moderate Reformed). Vacant offices "of helpers or *Sigristen*" were to be filled "by the pastors and parish churchwardens, and not otherwise" (Sehling 20/1, p. 226).

13.12.3 Schoolmasters, cantors and organists

The schoolmaster's oath. Schoolmasters, who with their pupils sang the services, were sworn to the council that employed them. Mulhouse's oath of 1551 (Reformed) binds the schoolmaster and his assistant to loyalty to the burgomaster and council, to diligent teaching of their lessons and the catechism, and to a good example. **Mulhouse, *Eid des Schulmeisters*, 1551** (Reformed; Sehling 20/2, p. 251):

A schoolmaster and his assistant shall swear to the burgomaster and council of the town of Mulhouse, as their lords and superiors, at all times to be faithful, loyal, obedient, serviceable and ready in all fit, seemly and just things […] diligently to attend to their office and the school at the appointed and fixed time, to have a faithful and diligent oversight of the youths committed to them, and to hold their appointed lessons and the catechism, with the hearing of the children, in order and as is fitting at all times

The Palatinate 1580: the schoolmaster's promise. The Palatine order of 1580 lists the "chapters on which every schoolmaster received in the Electoral Palatinate shall make promise". He is to remember that he must give account to God for his school; to teach the youth "with all friendliness" Luther's catechism as printed in the church order and no other, and nothing against the Book of Concord; to keep the school hours; to do what his office requires in church as well as school; to live without offence; to obey the church council, superintendent and pastor, answer at visitation and appear before the consistory; to be loyal to the Elector; to bring civil causes before the officers and spiritual causes before the church council; and not to leave his post without leave. The promise closes with handfast, oath and signature. **Palatinate, *Verzeichnuß etlicher capitum, darauf ein jeder schulmeister … promission thun solle*, 1580** (Sehling 14, pp. 508–509):

Ye, as a called schoolmaster, shall at all times diligently remember your calling and the school office committed unto you, and that ye shall give account thereof to God Almighty. Wherefore ye shall teach and instruct the youth of your school faithfully with all diligence, and with all friendliness and gentleness impress upon them well the catechism of Luther, as it is incorporated in the church order of our most gracious lord, abide thereby and use no other in your school; likewise teach nothing against the Christian Book of Concord […] All this to keep steadfast, firm and inviolable, and to perform all things else that become and befit a faithful servant of the school and an obedient subject, ye shall make promise and vow with hand given in faith, and swear also a bodily oath to God, and bind and oblige yourselves thereto by your own signature.

Gengenbach 1536 (Moderate Reformed). The schoolmaster of the imperial town of Gengenbach was bound by his *Bestallung* (appointment) to obey the council and two councillors and one minister set over him as "school-lords", to live blamelessly, and to follow the class divisions of Freiburg. **Gengenbach, *Bestallung eines Schulmeysters der Statt Gengenbach*, 1536** (Moderate Reformed; Sehling 17/1, p. 483):

A schoolmaster of the town of Gengenbach shall obey an honourable council in all fit things. First, two of the council and one of the ministers of the church shall be ordained as school-lords and shall have special oversight, with whose counsel he shall also deal in whatsoever is at any time most profitable for the youth. A schoolmaster shall be of blameless life, keep himself from all evil company, and apply himself in most Christian wise to the youth, to bring them up Christianly. […] As the church, so also shall the school serve to this end, that the youth be instructed most diligently in the Christian children's doctrine and so be taught for heaven, whereon all dependeth.

Organists: Hildesheim 1581. No organist's oath is printed in the corpus; Sehling notes one for Öhringen among the Hohenlohe oaths but does not print it (Sehling 15, p. 560). The organist's duties appear instead in contracts. The churchwardens of St Andrew's at Hildesheim engaged Severus Kroschen in 1581 for ten years, to play at Saturday Vespers and at Mass and Vespers on Sundays and feasts, and to keep the new organ in repair. In return he had a free house, sixty thalers a year paid quarterly "like the other ministers of church and school", and corn. **Hildesheim, *Bestallung des Organisten Severus Kroschen*, 1581** (Sehling 7/2.1, p. 901):

that we have taken on and appointed the worshipful and honest Severus Kroschen anew for ten years, to be reckoned from Michaelmas next coming, to be a servant and organist after the manner following: that he shall play every Saturday the Vespers, and on Sundays and other feast days the Mass and Vespers of the aforesaid church, and shall behave himself Christianly in his office, as hath not been otherwise hitherto. Moreover he shall also have the charge of the new organ faithfully and diligently, and in no wise neglect or omit anything whereby the work might come to harm and decay

Cantors. The cantor was one of the masters of the Latin school (at Hof in 1546 the cantor Georg Hertweg was the schoolmaster's colleague; §13.14.3) and was bound with the school staff. No separate cantor's oath is printed.

The schoolmaster's church duties are treated in Chapter 15, §15.9.

13.12.4 Churchwardens and stewards

Leisnig 1529. Churchwardens (*Kirchväter*, *Kirchenpfleger*, *Kastenherren*) were elected yearly and sworn. In Leisnig the Saxon visitors of 1529 had two "upright, able, pious men" chosen each year on the Sunday before Michaelmas, by the officer, the pastor, the council and eight deputies of the parish. They were sworn, took over the registers, deeds, stores, cash and keys from the old wardens on Michaelmas Day, and rendered a yearly account. **Leisnig, *Verordnung der Visitatoren für das Amt Leisnig*, 1529** (Sehling 1, p. 609):

so that every year, on the next Sunday before St Michael's Day, by the officer, the pastor, the council in office and the eight persons of the committee which the common parish hath to make among itself, two upright, able, pious men from among the inhabitants of the town shall be elected churchwardens and sworn as the need of that office requireth. On St Michael's Day the old churchwardens shall always deliver and show over to the newly appointed ones all registers of inheritance, bonds, deeds, stores, cash

Prussia 1575. In Prussia in 1575 the churchwardens were "chosen with the pastor's counsel and sworn and confirmed by the patrons" (Sehling 4, p. 153).

Saxe-Lauenburg 1585: the churchwarden's oath. Lauenburg gives the oath in the first person. It is followed by the reading of the warden's duties from the church order: to keep a book with copies of all the church's seals and deeds and the originals locked in the church; to record all its lands, rents and dues; and to render account. **Saxe-Lauenburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1585** (Sehling 5, p. 420):

The oath of a churchwarden. I, N., swear and vow to God Almighty that in this my office of churchwarden, whereunto I am now orderly chosen and appointed, I will be faithful and diligent; will know and further without neglect the good of the church and of the pastor in what is theirs, and prevent their harm; and in this whole office will perform faithfully all that belongeth thereto, according to my best ability and understanding: so help me God and his holy word.

The Palatinate 1577: the stewards of church property (Reformed). The *Kirchenschaffner*, the stewards of the former ecclesiastical property, swore loyalty to their two lords. **Palatinate, *Eid der Kirchenschaffner*, May 1577** (Reformed; Sehling 19/2, p. 749):

Ye shall vow and swear to my gracious prince and lord, Duke John Casimir, Count Palatine, etc., as your advocate, protector and defender and prince of the land, etc., and to the Count Palatine Lewis, Elector, etc., by reason of the half share in the revenues, to be faithful, loyal, obedient and ready, to warn and turn away harm from their electoral and princely graces, to seek and further their profit and good, faithfully and without guile.

Strasbourg 1523: the steward of the poor (Moderate Reformed). The Strasbourg poor order of 1523 set a *Schaffner* over the alms, who swore to the poor themselves. **Strasbourg, *Armenordnung*, longer version, 4 August 1523** (Moderate Reformed; Sehling 20/1, p. 113):

the steward shall swear a bodily oath to God and the saints, to be faithful and loyal to the poor folk, to procure their profit and advantage, to warn and turn away their harm, and also to be obedient and ready to the aforesaid appointed lords and nine wardens, and to render unto them every quarter of a year an honest, upright account of his receipts and expenses

Wittenberg 1533. At Wittenberg the six "pious, God-fearing" wardens (*Vorsteher*) of the common chest were appointed and sworn each year by the council and pastor (Sehling 1, p. 708).

Secretaries. No oath of a church secretary or clerk is printed. The Dithmarschen privilege of 1605 confirms the parishes' right of election, vocation and appointment (*bestallung*) of "all priests, schoolmasters, sextons, organists, parish clerks" (Sehling 23, p. 509).

13.12.5 Midwives

Lüneburg 1564. The midwife was in law a minister of baptism (§13.3.7). Many orders therefore had her chosen with the pastor and sworn. Lüneburg in 1564 ordered midwives to be appointed in every district by the officers, the pastor and the church jurors "with the counsel of understanding women". They were bound to use "no idolatry" at the birth but to seek help from God by prayer, and to serve the poor as faithfully as the rich. The pastors were to instruct them in emergency baptism, publicly and privately. **Lüneburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1564** (Sehling 6/1, pp. 557–558):

so we will firstly that by all the offices of every place, together with the pastor and the church jurors, with the counsel of understanding women, midwives be appointed everywhere who are God-fearing, diligent, faithful, able, and have a good name with every one. […] Such appointed midwives shall also bind themselves to use no idolatry with the women in their need, as hath often been found, but everywhere to seek help from God alone by Christian prayer and to use the appointed Christian means; likewise also be bound to be as diligent, willing and faithful with the poor as with the rich

The Ansbach theologians' agreement of 1556 required midwives to be "examined and instructed by the pastors", that they baptize no child unless it be wholly born (Sehling 11, p. 336). At Sangerhausen in 1540 the visitors had the midwives "sworn to the council" (Sehling 1, p. 656).

13.12.6 Deaconesses and sick-women

No ordination of deaconesses. No order ordains, blesses or installs a deaconess. The word *diaconissa* (deaconess) occurs only at Keppel in 1570, for the convent sister "who distributeth the alms", one of the offices the *domina* assigned among the sisters without any rite (Sehling 10, p. 141; §13.12.8). The women who did the work of the ancient deaconesses were received in three ways:

- **By election and handfast vow.** The Bohemian Brethren (Hussite) elected women elders (*presbyterae*) by the free vote of the women, with only women present. The elected bound themselves "by voice and by hand given" and received a place of honour, without laying on of hands (Sehling 4, p. 289). The form is quoted in Chapter 16 §16.6.4.
- **By appointment and examination.** The *Seelfrauen* (soul-women) and sick-women were appointed by the council. Regensburg in 1543 laid down what they were to say to the dying (Sehling 13, p. 410). At Nördlingen the superintendent asked that the women appointed by the council be sent to him to be examined and taught. This examination was their only induction. **Nördlingen, *Kirchenordnung Kaspar Löners*, 1544** (Sehling 12, p. 315):

If an honourable, wise council hath also, as I hear, appointed and taken on certain women for this, that they should tend the sick, I pray that they be sent to me, that I may inquire of their faith and understanding, and how they are wont to comfort and tend the sick, and teach them what they know not.

- **By instruction read to them.** Heilbronn in 1531 gathered its beguines into one house and set them to visit the sick and instruct them by God's word (see Chapter 16 §16.7.6). The council's deputies first had each house give its troth "in place of an oath" to declare all its goods for an inventory, and then read the instruction to them. **Heilbronn, *Instruktion zur Zusammenlegung beider Beginenhäuser*, 8 December 1531** (Sehling 17/1, p. 298):

First of all, let the beguines give their troth in place of an oath that they will declare, and keep back nothing at all of, all that belongeth to their house: ready money, jewels, silver plate, letters of rent, household stuff above and under ground, nothing excepted, whether it be in their hands or in other places, that it may all be written down and inventoried. Hereby it is not meant that it shall be taken from them, or they dispossessed of it, but that it come to their profit for the best in the one way as in the other. And when all is inventoried, then shall the instruction be read to them.

13.12.7 The clothing of a nun: Keppel 1570

The only evangelical rite of clothing. The order of Count John VI of Nassau-Dillenburg for the convent of Keppel prints the one complete evangelical form in the corpus for receiving a sister into a convent. Its conditions, set out first (Sehling 10, pp. 135–137), are these:

- the girl must have been brought up in the convent for at least two years and know the Christian doctrine;
- she must be at least twenty years old;
- her parents and kin must deliver a written bond (*Revers*) setting out what she renounces of her inheritance;
- she must bring a hundred gold florins.

The order of the rite. The rite itself (Sehling 10, pp. 137–141) runs as follows:

1. **In the convent hall,** at seven in the morning before the sermon, the candidate appears with her parents and kin before the count's officers, the *domina* and the whole convent. The superintendent declares that the count has consented to her clothing and reception, "yet in no other form and manner than our reformation and order bringeth with it".
2. **The order is read** through, except the articles on the election of the *domina*.
3. **Five questions to the parents and kin.** They are asked whether they are content with the order; whether they hold to the doctrine preached; whether they understand that the clothing does not mean that she may never marry or leave the convent, and will help her to an honourable marriage if she wishes; whether she has made any renunciation beyond the bond; and whether they will be thankful to the count and the convent. They promise this "with troth given by the hand", and two noblemen are set as sureties.
4. **Four questions to the *domina*.** Has the girl lived godly, obediently and modestly in the convent? Is the *domina* willing to receive her? Have the parents maintained her? Have the hundred florins been paid?
5. **Five questions to the candidate,** and the oath.
6. **The sermon,** on the true spiritual life, chastity, humility and obedience.
7. **The clothing.** The *domina* and the sisters lead her into the sacristy and put on her the convent's ordinary dress.
8. ***Veni Sancte Spiritus*** is sung before the altar.
9. **The exhortation** at the altar by the superintendent.
10. **The *Te Deum***, with *Benedicamus* and *Deo gratias*.

The questions and the oath. Nassau-Dillenburg, *Ordnung für das Kloster Keppel*, 1570 (Sehling 10, p. 138):

The maiden shall be asked: 1. Whether she betaketh herself into this convent unconstrained? 2. Whether she understandeth the chief parts of Christian doctrine, and will with God's help abide in the confession thereof, and never betake herself to any other religion? 3. Whether she hath read our order, sufficiently weighed and understood it, and will keep herself according to it in all things? 4. Whether she hath made, or promised and pledged yet to make, any renunciation to her parents, brothers or kin, secretly or openly, otherwise than the order containeth? 5. Whether she will take the customary oath according to the order. […] Form of the oath which the maidens shall take. Maiden N., etc., ye shall swear to God and his holy word that ye will by means of God's grace abide and continue steadfast in the one true christian religion, the saving doctrine of the holy gospel […] and likewise in the right use of the holy sacraments according to the institution and ordinance of our Lord Jesus Christ; that ye will also keep yourselves christianly and honourably in this estate, into which ye betake yourselves unconstrained and willingly […] that ye will show yourselves obedient toward the mother and the preacher in all godly, christian, honourable and reasonable things for the time of your abiding in this convent, [and] live peaceably and in unity with the other persons of the convent […] that ye will also not marry nor betake yourselves out of the convent without the knowledge and counsel of the magistrate, the mother and your parents and kin, that all may be done orderly, decently and honourably; all faithfully and without guile, so help you God and his holy word. And if she be willing to take this oath, she shall confirm and actually perform it by laying her right hand upon her left breast and with words from her own mouth.

The clothing. Nassau-Dillenburg, *Ordnung für das Kloster Keppel*, 1570 (Sehling 10, p. 139):

After the sermon the *domina* and the other maidens of the convent shall lead the maiden into the sacristy, and put on her the ordinary garments, as the other persons of the convent are otherwise clothed […] Thereafter they shall bring her before the altar and sing the *Veni Sancte Spiritus* (Come, Holy Spirit). But the superintendent shall make to her a declaration and exposition of the vow and oath she hath taken, with instruction to a godly, christian, honourable, virtuous and modest life and exhortation to all due obedience, after this manner or thereabouts.

The exhortation. The superintendent tells the new sister that the true spiritual estate is the one she entered at baptism. She is to beware of thinking that vows and habits earn forgiveness or are better than baptism. The convent is no prison but a school, from which God may call her to marriage, and if so she should marry in an orderly way with her family's help. **Nassau-Dillenburg, *Ordnung für das Kloster Keppel*, 1570** (Sehling 10, p. 139):

Ye shall also not suppose nor hold that ye are shut up here in the convent as in a prison and must abide therein all your life long, or that the vow of chastity and discipline cutteth off and forbiddeth you marriage (wherein is chastity also) and so entangleth your conscience; but that ye are in no other estate than other upright Christians which live in the world, save only that ye are held, as it were in a school, in continual exercise of christian devotion, in doctrine, in prayer, obedience, discipline, honesty and all manner of virtues; that hereafter, if God should call you to the estate of marriage or to aught else, ye may serve and go before many with doctrine and instruction, and also with christian conversation and good examples of all virtues.

The exhortation ends with a prayer that God "will grant his Holy Spirit both to you and to us all", and the rite closes. **Nassau-Dillenburg, *Ordnung für das Kloster Keppel*, 1570** (Sehling 10, p. 141):

Hereupon the maidens shall sing the hymn *Te Deum laudamus* (We praise thee, O God), and conclude with the *Benedicamus* and *Deo gratias*.

Elsewhere. The other convent orders put the clothing under the prince or council but print no rite. Lüneburg in 1574 allowed no child or maiden to be "clothed without our foreknowledge and command", and in a plain gown and white kerchief instead of the consecrated cowl, veil and crown (Sehling 6/1, p. 622). Strasbourg in 1555 required a petition to the council and a minimum age of eight (Sehling 20/1, p. 454). Goslar's convent of Frankenberg (1542) and Württemberg (1535) admitted no one (Sehling 7/2.2, p. 275; 16, p. 79).

13.12.8 The *domina*, the abbess and the prioress

Keppel 1570: election, confirmation, oath and presentation. The convent proposed two or three of its sisters. The count chose and confirmed one, and could depose her if she misbehaved. Before taking office she promised "in place of an oath" to keep the church and other orders, to govern the house faithfully, to hold the sisters to godliness and discipline, to alienate nothing of the convent's goods, to render a yearly account, to eat with the convent, and to tell the count and the kin if any sister meant to leave. **Nassau-Dillenburg, *Ordnung für das Kloster Keppel*, 1570, "The domina's oath"** (Sehling 10, pp. 141–142):

The *domina* shall vow and promise to us and the convent, in place of an oath, that she will abide by our christian church orders and all other orders, now delivered and hereafter to be set up and delivered, in all and every point, and hold to them earnestly and firmly; govern the convent faithfully and well; hold her maidens most diligently to all fear of God, obedience, discipline and honesty […] and finally keep herself for her own person christianly, honourably, uprightly, modestly, sincerely and blamelessly in all the aforesaid points and articles, so help her God and his divine name.

At her presentation to the convent the superintendent exhorts the sisters to obedience and reminds the *domina* of her "high office and heavy burden". He sets before her St Augustine's rule that the superior should "not exalt herself in her power" but serve in love, and be "loved more than feared" (Sehling 10, p. 142).

Schleswig-Holstein after 1610: election under oath. In the noble convents of the duchies the abbess of Itzehoe and the prioresses of the other houses were elected by the whole convent "according to old custom". The electors were sworn in the provost's presence to choose without favour, and the elected bound herself by oath to the convent. Then every sister swore obedience to her. **Schleswig-Holstein, *Klosterordnung für Frauenklöster*, after 1610** (Sehling 23, p. 182):

[It is ordained] that henceforth, as often as an abbess or prioress departeth, the assembly shall elect, not for favour or out of envy against others or for the sake of gain, but without any affection, with one accord, a person of their own number who knoweth the circumstances of the convent and is fit for the office, and can be profitable to preside over it and the convent, by virtue of an oath taken in the presence of their provost according to old custom; and she shall bind herself by oath to the convent, to preside over it faithfully. […] In like manner also, as often as an abbess at Itzehoe or a prioress in the other convents is elected, all the other maidens, and thereafter each one when she cometh to her raising, shall vow by oath, according to old custom, to be obedient to the abbesses and prioresses and not to set themselves against them.

Strasbourg 1555. In the city's remaining women's houses a "mother" and six "council-mothers", none under twenty-five, were to be chosen from the eldest and fittest. The mother and council-mothers were to "vow" to seek the convent's profit, ward off its harm and see that the sisters lived in christian discipline (Sehling 20/1, p. 456).

13.12.9 Monks, novices and evangelical abbots

No profession. No evangelical order admits a monk by profession or vow. Württemberg in 1535 and Goslar in 1542 forbade all admissions and sent unprofessed novices home (Sehling 16, p. 79; 7/2.2, p. 275). Duke Christoph in 1552 forbade the abbots to bind boys "with superstitious ceremonies and vows" to stay in the cloister (Sehling 16, p. 199).

Novices as scholars: Ravengiersburg 1560. Where a monastery was kept as a school, a youth was "received" with the prince's and the prior's knowledge and trained for the ministry. The only obligation laid on him was that of a stipendiary. **Pfalz-Simmern, *Klosterordnung Ravengiersburg*, 1560** (Sehling 19/2, p. 658):

And where there is any youth who for his wit and progress should be sent further, he shall be appointed to a university of our religion and maintained as need requireth. The same, [who] is so maintained, shall bind himself to serve no other lord than us and the house of God.

Evangelical abbots. The Württemberg prelates were invested with an oath, a sermon, *Komm Heiliger Geist* (Come, Holy Ghost), prayer at the altar and a blessing, and were presented to the school, the officers and the subjects (§13.11.3).

Monks who stayed. Esslingen in 1535 (Moderate Reformed) required no rite of the friars who chose to stay, and none of those who left to marry. The council simply gave a settlement to the one and maintenance to the other (Sehling 17/2, p. 382).

13.12.10 Laying aside the habit

A rite of separation without a rite. The medieval consecration of virgins gave the nun a blessed veil and crown with the words of the bridal antiphons. When she left, she was said to have lost "the crown of her head". The evangelical orders gave no rite for laying the habit aside. But Brunswick-Wolfenbüttel in 1569 supplied the words with which a sister might answer that reproach. She has not lost her spiritual garment and crown, for she received them in baptism. She lays the cowl and crown aside in God's name, so that no one may think she trusts in them, and so that her sisters "the maidens and wives" take no offence. **Brunswick-Wolfenbüttel, *Klosterordnung*, 1569** (Sehling 6/1, pp. 325–326):

Therefore when a maiden layeth down such cloister garments together with her crown, it cannot be said to her with truth that she hath laid down the spiritual garments, much less: *Cecidit corona capitis tui*, thou hast lost the crown of thy bridegroom; but she can turn it about and say: Even for this cause, that I may keep my spiritual garment pure and unspotted, and likewise the crown upon my head, which were put on me and set upon me in holy baptism, have I laid down the cowl and the outward crown [...] so will I in the name of almighty God lay from me my cowl, scapular and outward crown, that every one may see and perceive in the deed that I am in earnest, that I have set no hope of salvation thereon, and hold such a garment in my heart no otherwise than another garment.

Burial. Lüneburg in 1574 ordered that no person of the cloister be buried "in cowl, scapular, veil, etc., but in a linen sheet like other Christians" (Sehling 6/1, p. 622).

13.13 Magistrates and civil offices

No rite in the orders. The church orders contain no rite for installing a magistrate, swearing in a council or crowning a prince. These acts belonged to the civil constitution of each town and territory, and their oaths and ceremonies are not printed by Sehling. What the orders do contain falls into three groups.

13.13.1 The council-election sermon

Schwäbisch Hall. Some cities joined the yearly change of council to a sermon on the office of the magistrate. Schwäbisch Hall's order (1543, as revised in 1615) appoints a "special sermon on the office of the magistrate (called the election or council sermon)" every year in St Michael's on the Sunday before St Mary Magdalene. It gives the texts for it. **Schwäbisch Hall, *Kirchenordnung*, 1543/1615** (Sehling 17/1, p. 165):

There shall also be held yearly on the Sunday before St Mary Magdalene in the church of St Michael a special sermon on the office of the magistrate (called the election or council sermon), whereat the subjects also are to be reminded of their office; thereto are especially serviceable the texts Exodus 18; Deuteronomy 16; 2 Chronicles 19; Romans 13; Titus 3; 1 Peter 2, etc.

Memmingen and Konstanz (both Moderate Reformed). Memmingen in 1532 had half the churchwardens step down "every year at the new council" (Sehling 12, p. 252). At Konstanz the yearly council election also chose the spokesmen who sat on the

city's disciplinary court (Sehling 17, p. 386, editor's note).

13.13.2 Prayer for the magistrate

The standing intercession for "the emperor, princes and lords, and all magistrates" in the general prayer of every service was the church's ordinary act toward the civil power. The forms are collected in Chapter 6.

13.13.3 Oaths of homage

Homage oaths. When a new prince succeeded, all subjects owed him the oath of homage (*Erbhuldigung*), clergy included. The orders mention this only where the clergy's position was in question:

- **Württemberg, about 1563.** The Württemberg instruction for the evangelical prelates printed the homage oath they swore to the duke as protector of their monasteries (Sehling 16, p. 441).
- **The Palatinate, 1585** (Reformed). In 1585 the administrator Johann Casimir ordered the officers to take all ministers and schoolmasters "into the obligation of homage". He gave as the reason that in the Palatinate "even the meanest peasant" did not go without "the customary homage of the land" (Sehling 19/2, p. 756).
- **The Palatinate, 1601** (Reformed). In 1601 the Elector reminded the clergy of the Upper Palatinate that in "political and civil matters" they stood under his officers like other subjects (Sehling 14, p. 590).

13.14 Dedication of churches and the *Kirchweih*

No consecration rite. No evangelical order in Sehling contains a rite for consecrating a church, an altar or a churchyard. The bishop's consecration had been one of the episcopal acts that the Reformation lost along with the bishops (§13.10). The orders treat it in two ways: as a superstition to be abolished, and, in one case, as an anniversary to be kept with a sermon on the history of the building. The annual *Kirchweih* (church dedication festival; also called *Kirchmesse* [parish fair], *Kirmes* [parish fair] or *Kirbe* [parish fair]), the dedication festival with its fair, feasting and dancing, was handled as a matter of police: it was restricted, moved off Sunday or forbidden.

13.14.1 Dedication rejected

Homberg 1526 (Moderate Reformed). The Homberg synod forbade the churches to keep dedications at all. There is no stone temple in the church after Christ; the faithful themselves are the living temples. Each believer is to keep the "consecration of the church" in his heart, by thanksgiving for his calling. **Hesse, *Reformatio ecclesiarum Hassiae* (Homberg), 1526** (Moderate Reformed; Sehling 8, p. 50):

We forbid all our churches, in the power of Christ, to celebrate dedications any longer, because they agree not with the word of the Lord […] Finally, after Christ there is in the church of God no temple of stone, properly so called, but the faithful alone and the church itself are the living temples of God. […] Now if there be no temple, then truly the dedication thereof is not to be celebrated. Let every one of the faithful celebrate in his own heart the consecration of the church, as holily as he can; which he doth as often as, rejoicing in the Lord, he giveth thanks for his own calling and that of all the faithful.

Halberstadt 1588. The Halberstadt visitation instruction of 1588 made the point within the general rule on ceremonies. Indifferent things (vestments, candles on the altar, Latin or German singing) were to stay as each church had them. But "offensive, superstitious ceremonies, even if they were old", were to be abolished. Among them it names the church dedication and the blessing of the font. **Halberstadt, *Instruktion für die Visitation*, 8 August 1588** (Sehling 2, p. 470):

but offensive, superstitious ceremonies, though they were old, shall be abolished: as idolatrous images, where any worship be paid them, the sacrament-house and monstrance, the elevation, the adoration, church-hallowing, font-hallowing and the like.

Churchyards. The same reasoning applied to churchyards. The Schwäbisch Hall order, in its funeral sermon, explains that the churchyard is kept honourable and holy for the dead who lie in it, not for any consecration of the ground. **Schwäbisch Hall, *Kirchenordnung*, 1543/1615** (Sehling 17/1, p. 175):

But that the churchyards should be kept honourable and holy, that is not to be ascribed to the place itself and its hallowing, as the adversaries pretend, but is done because of the bodies of the dead that lie therein […] For the place maketh not the dead holy, but the dead maketh the place holy.

13.14.2 Opening a new church or churchyard

A sermon in place of a rite. Where a new church or burial ground was brought into use, the orders give no form. What the corpus records are the occasions, and they point to a festal service with a sermon in place of a consecration:

- **Hohenlohe, 1562.** Johann Hofmann preached a "sermon on the right consecration of a churchyard and its church" at the opening of a new cemetery and its church on 16 July 1562. It was printed with his funeral sermons in 1599 (Sehling 15, p. 243, editor's note).
- **Hof, 1546 and 1572.** The two Hof dedications are described in §13.14.3.
- **Colmar, 1575.** The Franciscan church in the hospital at Colmar was "brought to the right use and dedicated" (*eingeweyhet*) for evangelical preaching on 15 May 1575. The deacon David Hiemeyer recalled the first service in a print of 1590 (Sehling 20/2, p. 478, editor's note).
- **Waldenburg, 1591.** The new church at Waldenburg in Hohenlohe was to be "dedicated" on 1 January 1591. Count Georg Friedrich asked for a share of the old Mass vestments and copes of Öhringen "for its adornment" (Sehling 15, p. 431, editor's note).
- **Henneberg, 1635.** The Henneberg consistory reported in 1635 that "when a new church or pulpit is built, the dedication is done by the special superintendent" (Sehling 2, p. 326). This report falls outside the period, and no form is given.

13.14.3 Hof: the dedication of 1572 and its yearly festival

The dedication of 1572. St Michael's at Hof in the margraviate of Kulmbach is the one evangelical church whose dedication is described with its participants, date and yearly commemoration. The church was rebuilt and "dedicated or entered" (*dedication oder bezihung*) on the eighth Sunday after Trinity, 27 July 1572. The order of 1592 names those who performed it:

- the captain of Hof, Hans Paul von Schaumberg;
- the superintendent, Master Andreas Pangratius;
- Johann Sahr, pastor of the hospital;
- Jacob Schlemmer, schoolmaster, and Laurentius Codomannus, rector of the school.

The order does not print the form used in 1572. It does give the festival by which the dedication was kept every year, and that festival repeats what the 1592 order says was done "in Christian wise" on the day: a procession of the whole town, the sermon on the building, and the dedication Mass and Vespers. **Hof, *Ordo ecclesiasticus*, 1592** (Sehling 11, p. 467):

All this is done for this cause: that in the year of Christ 1572, after the fair parish church of St Michael had been wholly built out and brought into the form it now hath, the dedication or entering thereof was undertaken and performed in Christian wise upon this eighth Sunday after Trinity, which was then the 27th of July; when the strict, noble and worshipful Hans Paul von Schaumberg was captain here, the reverend and well-learned Master Andreas Pangratius, of pious memory, superintendent, Master Johann Sahr, of pious memory, pastor in the hospital, Master Jacob Schlemmer schoolmaster, and beside him Master Laurentius Codomannus (afterwards pastor at Bayreuth) rector of our school. But that such dedication may be kept in fresh remembrance, and the cause thereof be impressed upon the people at a set time, it was laudably and well ordained by the aforesaid Master Andreas Pangratius, and left to his successors, that it should be kept yearly and solemnly celebrated.

The yearly festival. The rite of the festival runs:

1. **Assembly.** After the second peal the clergy, the council, the whole town and the schoolgirls gather at the Franciscan (cloister) church, the schoolboys at the school.
2. **Procession.** At the full peal the schoolboys, crowned with wreaths, go in through the old cloister door, round behind the stalls under the nuns' gallery and out at the great door, singing *Sei Lob und Ehr mit hohem Preis* (Praise and honour be with high praise). The whole town follows them in procession to St Michael's. On the way the boys sing *Erhalt uns, Herr, bei deinem Wort* (Keep us, Lord, by thy word), *Laetatus sum* (Gallus Dressler) and *Laus Deo fonti bonorum*. The schoolgirls and women follow, singing *Sei Lob und Ehr* (Praise and honour be to the highest good) and *Herr Gott, dich loben wir* (Lord God, we praise thee). The neighbours strew the lane with grass and set May-boughs on either side "to the honour of God and his church".
3. **Sermon.** The superintendent, in alternate years, either summarizes the Gospel and tells at length the history of the church "from trustworthy old letters, the report of old people and other sure evidence", or summarizes that history and expounds a point of the Sunday Gospel.

4. **Mass and Vespers** with the dedication propers (below).

Hof, *Ordo ecclesiasticus*, 1592 (Sehling 11, p. 467):

The eighth Sunday after Trinity, on which is celebrated the dedication of the church of St Michael. This eighth Sunday after Trinity, on which the feast of the church-hallowing at St Michael's is wont to be kept, is observed with special ceremonies and church pomp: in that the spiritual and the temporal estate, and also the whole burghership, men and women, and the schoolgirls also, after the second peal is heard, gather before the cloister church (but the scholars in the school); and when all the bells are rung together, with the scholars (who then, adorned with fair wreaths, go in at the door where of old the cloister walk was, into the cloister church, then round behind the stalls by the nuns' gallery and out again at the foremost great door beside their masters, singing *Sei Lob und Ehr mit hohem Preis*), they betake themselves in an orderly procession, as is said above at Whit Monday also, into St Michael's or the parish church, and there wait upon the divine service.

The propers. The order gives the music of the *Officium dedicationis templi* (Office of the dedication of a church). It keeps the texts of the old Mass and Office of a church's dedication in polyphonic settings:

- **Introit:** *Terribilis est locus iste* (Dreadful is this place), followed by a Mass of Georg Forster.
- **After the epistle:** *Verba mea auribus percipe* (Give ear to my words; Lassus).
- **After the Gospel:** *Levavi oculos meos* (I lifted up mine eyes; Lassus).
- **In place of *Nun bitten wir*:** *Benedic, Domine, domum istam* (Bless, O Lord, this house; Johannes de Hollande).
- **At Vespers:** the antiphon *In domum Domini ibimus* (We will go into the house of the Lord), Psalm 116 (*Dilexi*), the responsory *Si bona suscepimus* (If we have received good things), the hymn *O lux beata*, and *Erhalt uns, Herr, bei deinem Wort* in place of the Magnificat (Sehling 11, p. 468).
- **In the psalter of the Office:** for the feast of the dedication, the antiphon *In domum Domini laetantes ibimus* (We will go into the house of the Lord rejoicing) with Psalm 84, *Quam dilecta tabernacula* (How amiable are thy tabernacles; Sehling 11, p. 422).

The school dedication of 1546. The same order describes a second dedication at Hof, kept yearly on Whit Monday with the same kind of procession. Margrave Albrecht gave the empty Franciscan friary to the town in 1543 for a school. Its "dedication", set for 1545, was put off by plague. On Whit Monday 1546 the town went in procession from the parish church to the cloister church, and after the service the schoolmaster and his colleagues led the boys into the new school, where the superintendent exhorted them. Each year the town walked, with the schoolboys in wreaths (the lower classes in the white shirts their godparents had given them), from St Michael's to the cloister church singing *Veni Sancte Spiritus* (Come, Holy Spirit), *Apparuerunt apostolis* and *Sei Lob und Ehr*. **Hof, *Ordo ecclesiasticus*, 1592** (Sehling 11, p. 464):

in which, upon the aforesaid Whit Monday, a procession was held out of the parish church into the cloister church; and after the divine service was done, Master Jacob Schlemmer, schoolmaster […] together with his two colleagues, namely Georg Hertweg, cantor, and Wolfgang Döberlein, bachelor […] led the scholars into the new school, exhorted them to all good in the presence of Master Leonhard Eberhard as pastor and superintendent, and then after a few days they began to do their exercises therein.

Regensburg, about 1567. Regensburg kept a comparable anniversary. On the Sunday after 15 October the choir sang figural music "on account of the dedication of the temple". That day marked the beginning, in 1542, of evangelical preaching and the Lord's Supper in the church (Sehling 13, p. 475). There was no consecration; the festival commemorated the Reformation of the church.

13.14.4 The *Kirchweih* festival

A police matter. The popular *Kirchweih* (church dedication festival) survived the abolition of the rite. Most orders handled it only as a problem of police: the feasting, drinking and dancing, and the fairs that kept people from the Sunday sermon. Three degrees of severity appear:

Treatment	Examples
Moved off Sunday or kept behind the sermon	Mecklenburg 1552: no *Kirchmessen* or fairs on Sunday (Sehling 5, p. 220); Hesse 1571 (Philippist): the Landgraves' instruction proposed Monday (Sehling 8, p. 359, editor's note); archbishopric of Bremen (Vörde) 1577: no booths opened until sermon and service were over (Sehling 7/1, p. 24)

Treatment	Examples
Tolerated with limits	Saxony 1580: one day of dancing at each village *Kirmes* (parish fair), by daylight (Sehling 1, p. 442); Nassau-Weilburg 1609: dancing at customary *Kirmes* and fairs once or twice a year, for an hour or three (Sehling 10, p. 339)
Abolished outright	Baden 1548 and 1564 (Sehling 16, pp. 518, 537); Waldeck 1583; Hohenlohe 1586 (Sehling 15, p. 521), with Schwäbisch Hall the same year (Sehling 15, p. 587, editor's note); a Palatine police ordinance (Sehling 14, p. 66, editor's note); Solms 1582 and 1594 (Reformed; Sehling 9, pp. 325, 337). Hohenlohe in 1579 forbade the clergy to go to one another's *Kirchweih* (Sehling 15, p. 380)

Waldeck 1583. Waldeck's mandate of 1583 is typical. The festivals "derive from the papacy" and breed "all wantonness and levity". They had already been abolished in the neighbouring electorates, principalities and counties, and the pastors were to announce the abolition from the pulpit on two Sundays. **Waldeck, *Mandat zur Abschaffung der Kirchweihfeste*, 8 August 1583** (Sehling 9, p. 299):

Whereas we are informed by the report of our church visitors that at the church-ales, which come from the papacy and are kept by our subjects until now, all wantonness and levity is practised, cherished and carried on contrary to God's holy word and commandments […] and we therefore know not to suffer and permit any longer among our subjects such church-ales, which have long since been abolished in our neighbouring electorates and principalities, counties and lordships

Danzig 1612. In 1612 Danzig noted in its list of the sexton's fees that the church's dedication festival, with three feasts of Mary, was "now no longer held for a great feast, nor kept" (Sehling 4, p. 206). Mulhouse in 1524 (Reformed) had already struck the dedication feast of Basel minster from its calendar (Sehling 20, p. 163, editor's note).

13.15 Blessings of objects and their abolition

The medieval blessings. The late medieval church year carried a cycle of blessings of things:

- holy water and salt every Sunday, with the sprinkling (*Asperges*);
- candles at Candlemas;
- ashes on Ash Wednesday and palms on Palm Sunday;
- the new fire, the paschal candle and the font on Holy Saturday;
- the Easter basket (*Fladen*, eggs, meat) on Easter Day;
- herbs at the Assumption;
- St John's wine (*Johannisminne*) on 27 December;
- bells "baptized" against storms.

The chrism and holy oils were consecrated by the bishop on Maundy Thursday.

Uniform abolition. No evangelical order kept any of these blessings. They are abolished in almost the same words from the Pomesanian bishop's articles of 1524 to the end of the century. The grounds are always the same three:

- the creatures are already sanctified by God's word at creation and by thanksgiving (1 Timothy 4:4–5);
- there is no command or promise of God for the blessing;
- the blessed things had become means of "superstition and sorcery".

What survived were the bare actions where they served preaching or prayer: the Sunday procession without water, bell-ringing as a call to prayer, the chrism at baptism in two orders. The wreath survived as a civil sign of honour, not a blessed object.

13.15.1 The lists of abolished blessings

Pomesania 1524. The earliest list is in the articles which Erhard von Queiss, bishop of Pomesania, published at the end of 1524. **Pomesania, *Themata episcopi Risenburgensis*, 1524** (Sehling 4, p. 29):

Henceforth no water, salt, ashes, palms, candles, herbs and the like shall be hallowed; for it is all men's toys and profiteth nowhere.

Pfalz-Neuburg 1543. The fullest list is in the Pfalz-Neuburg order of 1543, which follows Brandenburg-Nürnberg 1533 (Sehling 11, p. 203). It goes through the year feast by feast. **Pfalz-Neuburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1543** (Sehling 13, pp. 96–97):

Neither shall men any more hallow or bless holy water and salt, as was done every Sunday, nor wax at Candlemas, nor ashes on Ash Wednesday, nor palms on Palm Sunday, nor the Easter candle, nor the font, nor fire on Easter Eve, nor cakes, eggs, flesh on Easter Day, nor roots or herbs at the Assumption of Mary, nor wine on the day of St John the Evangelist; for such blessings are all unagreeable and contrary to the word of God, in part also idolatrous, and serve more to superstition than to godliness.

The reasons. Nassau-Dillenburg's order of 1537 sets out the reasons at length. Pastors are not merely to stop blessing but to teach the people why. **Nassau-Dillenburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1537** (Sehling 10, p. 76):

The pastors and ministers of the church also shall henceforth no more hallow salt, fire, light, fruit, herb, but shall nevertheless instruct the people why this is rightly left off. For such creatures are created good by God, each one for its use, Genesis 1, and are sanctified and hallowed by God, for the faithful to enjoy with thanksgiving, 1 Timothy 4; therefore they need not our hallowing […] where is there a word of God that saith that holy water taketh away or washeth off daily sins, refresheth the souls in the churchyard, driveth the devil out of houses; item, that hallowed herb or hallowed light and palms avail against the tempest?

Further lists. The same list, shorter or longer, recurs throughout the corpus:

Order	Blessings named	Sehling
Brandenburg-Nürnberg 1533	St John's blessing, wax, palms, fire, *Fladen* (flat cakes), salt, water, herbs	11, p. 203
Nassau-Dillenburg 1537	salt, fire, light, fruit, herbs; holy water, palms	10, p. 76
Freiberg 1538	water, salt, *Fladen*, roots, palms, oats	1, p. 467
Brandenburg 1540	water and salt, Sunday sprinkling, herbs, candles	3, p. 88
Saxony (Albertine) 1540	sprinkling, salt and water	1, p. 285
Calenberg-Göttingen 1542	salt, water, herbs, palms, *Fladen*	6/2, p. 799
Merseburg 1544	water, salt, light, roots	2, p. 13
Hohenlohe 1553	as Pfalz-Neuburg 1543	15, p. 76
Lüneburg convents 1555	palms, Easter candle, water, fire (blessed by the prioress)	6/1, p. 615
Thüngen 1564	waters, salt, herbs, candles, "St John's Gospel"	11, p. 740
Wolfstein 1574	water, fire, herbs, fruit, *Fladen*, eggs, bacon, meat	13, p. 574
Teschen 1584	candles, herbs, water, salt	3, p. 460
Halberstadt 1588	water, fire, salt, herbs (visitation question)	2, p. 470

Calenberg-Göttingen 1542. Calenberg-Göttingen gives the shortest form of the argument. **Calenberg-Göttingen, *Kirchenordnung*, 1542** (Sehling 6/2, p. 799):

Of the hallowing of salt, water, herbs, palms and cakes. Since all creatures were richly and sufficiently blessed and hallowed by the word at the time of the creation, and nothing further is here required of the believer but that he use them well and with thanksgiving, 1 Timothy 4, therefore such hallowing, since it hath no ground in Scripture, shall be wholly abolished.

Lüneburg convents 1555. The Lüneburg convent reform of 1555 shows how long the blessings could survive inside the cloister. The prioress (*domina*) had for a time been blessing the palms, the Easter candle, water and fire herself. This "did not belong to her", and was to stop (Sehling 6/1, p. 615).

13.15.2 What was kept in place of the blessing

Brandenburg 1540. Electoral Brandenburg abolished the blessings but kept the Sunday procession round the church, now without water, with a pure responsory or a seasonal hymn. **Brandenburg (Electorate), *Kirchenordnung* of Joachim II, 1540**

(Sehling 3, p. 88):

The hallowing of water and salt, together with the Sunday sprinkling, and likewise the hallowing of herbs, candles and other things, shall be left off, for it hath no divine command and is turned to great abuse and sorcery; but the Sunday procession, with a pure responsory or other chant as the season giveth, and with the leaving off of the abuses aforesaid, shall remain.

13.15.3 The blessing of the font

Font blessing abolished. The solemn blessing of the font on Holy Saturday and the eve of Pentecost, with the chrism and the paschal candle, was dropped everywhere. The Brandenburg-Nürnberg articles of 1528 already said that "blessing of the font shall be left off, since we have neither command nor example for it in Scripture". The people were to be taught why before it was stopped (Sehling 11, p. 136). Bugenhagen's Lübeck order of 1531 put the reason in a phrase: "water is water, blessing is blessing" (Sehling 5, p. 354). The water in which a child is baptized is ordinary water, and the word of institution makes the sacrament (§13.3.1).

13.15.4 Chrism and holy oils

Chrism dropped. The chrism and the oils, which only a bishop could consecrate, disappeared with the post-baptismal anointing (§13.3.2) and extreme unction (§13.8.1). The *Straßburger Kirchenampt* (Strasbourg church office) of 1525 (Moderate Reformed) said that oil, chrism and "the enchanted water" were no longer used at baptism, because the people trusted in them (Sehling 20, p. 153). Luther's Saxon visitors in 1528 would not quarrel over the chrism: "the right chrism, with which all Christians are anointed by God himself, is the Holy Ghost" (Sehling 1, p. 158).

Kept by two orders. Two orders kept the chrism at baptism as an "ancient ceremony" with a teaching meaning: Electoral Brandenburg in 1540 and Pfalz-Neuburg in 1543, which copied it. Brandenburg explained that the anointing signified the royal priesthood of Christians. The people were to be taught that the Holy Ghost, not the chrism, anoints, and children baptized in emergency were not to be anointed afterwards (Sehling 3, p. 54; quoted in §13.3.2). Neither order says who consecrated the chrism. In Pfalz-Neuburg Ottheinrich suspended the chrism section and issued a new baptismal order (Sehling 13, p. 22, editor's note). When he succeeded to the Palatinate in 1556 he ordered baptism "without chrism" (Sehling 14, p. 112).

13.15.5 Bells and weather-ringing

Bell baptism. Bells were "baptized" with chrism and salt and named. The rung bell was believed to drive off storms, hail and the demons in them. The evangelical orders never blessed a bell. They divided over the ringing itself.

Saxony 1528. The Saxon *Unterricht der Visitatoren* (Instruction of the Visitors) of 1528 (repeated in 1539) let weather-ringing continue, re-explained as a call to prayer. Between the two passages quoted it explains that God sends storms as punishment and good weather as his gift (Leviticus 26, Deuteronomy 28). The passage (with the whole end of its chapter) is missing from the edition of 1538, according to Sehling's apparatus. **Saxony (Ernestine), *Unterricht der Visitatoren*, 1528** (Sehling 1, pp. 170–171):

But since the same ringing was afterwards misused, and it was held that the bells (and perchance for this cause, that men had for a time undertaken to hallow them) should drive away the weather, it were not amiss that the preachers in summertime admonished the people that, when a storm ariseth and men ring, this custom is kept to this end: not that the sound of the bells and the hallowing of the bells driveth away the weather or the frost, as hath been taught and held hitherto, but that men be thereby reminded to pray God to preserve us the fruits of the earth. […] If now the ringing were done away, the people would perchance be the less reminded that the weather cometh from God, and would call upon God the less. The people would also grow the wilder if they were not admonished to pray God for life and sustenance. Yet the preacher must do this far better than the bells, else a devil's game would come of it, as it was before.

Saxony 1580. The later Saxon order of 1580 abolished weather-ringing outright, because of the bell baptism behind it. **Saxony, *Ordnung* of Duke August, 1580** (Sehling 1, p. 453):

But especially shall the superstitious and idolatrous weather-ringing (for which cause the bells in the papacy are baptized, with blasphemous misuse of Christ's institution, that they may have the power to turn away hail and harmful weather), where it is still in use, be abolished and not permitted; but instead the people shall be exhorted to repentance and to Christian, fervent prayer.

Hohenlohe 1582. Hohenlohe in 1582 kept a middle way. The people had been taught that "bell baptism is a horrible misuse of holy baptism, a blasphemy". One bell might be rung moderately as a call to prayer, but not all bells together nor for as long as the storm lasted (Sehling 15, p. 452).

Other territories. Other territories ended weather-ringing by mandate:

- Coburg 1554/55 (Sehling 1, p. 544, cited by the editor);
- Thüngen 1564 (Sehling 11, p. 741);
- Pfalz-Neuburg 1560 and 1576 (Sehling 13, pp. 139, 194);
- the Upper Palatinate 1557 and 1579, which in 1579 allowed one bell at night "to rouse and exhort the people to prayer" (Sehling 13, pp. 296, 316);
- Nassau-Weilburg 1576 (Sehling 10, p. 310);
- Ysenburg-Birstein 1583 (Sehling 10, p. 616);
- Limpurg 1610, which regulated it (Sehling 16, p. 623).

Weather-ringing among the other uses of the bells is treated in Chapter 9, §9.5.8.

13.15.6 Wreaths and other signs

Wreaths. The bridal wreath was not blessed but survived as a sign of honour. It was withheld from a bride who had lost her virginity (§13.7). At Hof in 1592 the schoolboys walked crowned with wreaths in the dedication procession (§13.14.3).

Popular survivals. Rural police ordinances dealt with surviving popular rites as superstition rather than liturgy, including the Easter and St John's fires and the use of "St John's Gospel" as a charm (§13.12.2): Nassau-Weilburg 1576 (Sehling 10, p. 310), Hesse 1608 (Reformed; Sehling 9, p. 61) and the Thüngen order.

13.16 The ban, excommunication, public penance and reconciliation

The medieval ban rejected. The evangelical orders began by rejecting the medieval ban, which was pronounced by officials for debts and fees and enforced by interdict. The Pomesanian articles of 1524 declared that "henceforth there shall be no ban which burdens consciences without ground in God's word and compels by human ordinance alone" (Sehling 4, p. 29).

Matthew 18 and 1 Corinthians 5. In its place almost every order set up a scriptural ban on the pattern of Matthew 18:15–17 and 1 Corinthians 5. The steps were:

1. private admonition;
2. admonition before witnesses;
3. report to the church (the consistory, the superintendent or the elders);
4. exclusion.

Exclusion was in two grades:

- **The lesser ban** (*kleiner Bann*, *separatio*, *excommunicatio minor*): exclusion from the Sacrament and from standing as godparent, without public announcement.
- **The greater ban** (*großer Bann*, *excommunicatio major*): public exclusion from the congregation, "delivering to Satan", with civil consequences.

The return was by public penance (*öffentliche Buße*, *Kirchenbuße*) and absolution before the congregation.

Who could ban. The orders differ chiefly on who held the power:

- **Lutheran consistories.** In the Lutheran territories the consistory decided and the pastor pronounced. The consistory was a court of theologians and jurists acting for the prince.
- **Hesse (Ziegenhain 1539)** (Moderate Reformed). Hesse set elders beside the pastor, and the ban was pronounced before them "and for the time being not before the whole congregation" (Sehling 8, p. 108).
- **The Reformed.** In the Reformed orders the power lay "not with one or several ministers" but with the whole congregation, exercised through elders: the Palatinate 1563 (Sehling 14, p. 388) and the London stranger church (Micron), both Reformed.

13.16.1 Lesser and greater ban

Grubenhagen 1581. Grubenhagen distinguished ordinary church discipline from the ban proper. The public rebuke of open sinners and their quiet refusal at confession "is no excommunication or ban, but a reminder to repentance". The ban is final. **Grubenhagen, *Kirchenordnung*, 1581** (Sehling 6/2, p. 1052):

But thirdly there is a difference between the common punishments of the church and excommunication or the ban. For the public rebuke of open sinners, together with the secret turning away from the sacrament which taketh place in confession or otherwise, is no excommunication or ban, but a reminder to repentance and to the putting away of the offence given. But the ban is a final shutting out of the obdurate from the Christian congregation, and a delivering to Satan for the destruction of the flesh.

Lauenburg 1585: the lesser ban. Lauenburg names the grades. After the general preaching of the law and private admonition by the pastor and superintendent, the obstinate sinner is turned away from the Supper, from standing godparent and from leading a bride. **Saxe-Lauenburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1585** (Sehling 5, p. 448):

such an obstinate man shall be turned away for a time, as an unchristian and ungodly man, from the holy Supper, from standing godfather at baptism and from standing by the bride or leading her at the betrothal, until he do right and true repentance. This is the *separatio* (separation) or lesser ban, as the ancients call it, and it is done without public announcement before the people from the pulpit, but privately only, or in the presence of one or more preachers, or of Christians called thereto.

13.16.2 The Lutheran form of excommunication: Wittenberg 1542

Wittenberg 1542. The Wittenberg consistory's constitution of 1542 was the first evangelical order to give a written form. No pastor may excommunicate without the consistory's judge. The consistory decides, and the pastor announces the sentence publicly in church "before the congregation, for St Paul says *congregatis omnibus vobis*". The excommunicate may come only to the sermon. He is denied the sacrament and the office of godparent, and is to be buried without song or ceremony, "in the field". A civil penalty follows: suspension from office or the council, or from his trade. **Electoral Saxony, *Constitution und artikel des geistlichen consistorii zu Wittemberg*, 1542** (Sehling 1, p. 206):

Form of excommunication. Forasmuch as Hans N. hath forgotten his baptism, followed the devil and committed adultery (here let the sin committed be named), for which he hath been many times brotherly admonished and reminded to desist therefrom, and yet wilfully, to the destruction of his own soul, continueth therein, so that no counsel nor help for his amendment is to be hoped for: therefore we put the said Hans N. into the ban, by the power of the keys which Christ hath given to his church and left on earth to bind the impenitent therewith, and shut him out of the assembly of the holy Christian church. We forbid him also hereby the use of the Christian sacraments, until he turn himself and acknowledge, and return again to him who reached his hand to the sinking Peter and will have no sinner lost. I remind also herewith all who know themselves obedient members of the Christian church, that they shun the same Hans N. as a wilful and impenitent man, lest they defile themselves with him and make themselves partakers of other men's sins.

Reconciliation. The order provides for reconciliation only in outline. The banned man asks grace, gives a pledge of amendment, and "is absolved by the congregation, who shall pray for him and rejoice heartily at his return" (Sehling 1, p. 207).

13.16.3 The full Lutheran rite: Saxe-Lauenburg 1585

Lauenburg 1585. Saxe-Lauenburg gives the most complete Lutheran liturgy of the ban and of public penance in Sehling. The procedure runs:

1. Private admonition by the pastor; then before two or three witnesses (churchwardens or elders).
2. Report to the superintendent, then to the consistory, which summons and hears the sinner.
3. If he remains obstinate, the consistory sentences him to the greater ban.
4. The sentence is announced the next Sunday. After the sermon the sinner is set "in the choir before all the people". The superintendent or pastor reads the sentence from the pulpit or before the altar.
5. Before communion begins, the sexton leads the excommunicate out through the people.
6. The officer forbids him weddings, feasts, taverns and "honourable company". He may work, buy and sell, and must stand in a separate place in church at every sermon, leaving before the rest of the service.

The sentence. The sentence closes with a prayer for the banned man. **Saxe-Lauenburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1585** (Sehling 5, p. 449):

the appointed members of the church council in the consistory, after sufficient proceedings held, have judged this man to this end: that in the presence of you all he shall be shut out of the holy Christian church, and also at the same time be turned away as one unworthy from the holy Supper of the true, life-giving and present body and blood of Christ, and also not stand godfather at holy baptism, nor lead bride or bridegroom to the betrothal [...] until he let open repentance, contrition and sorrow for these his terrible sins, together with right Christian amendment, be perceived and appear in him. Yet to the sermon he may and shall come freely and unhindered [...] Almighty, everlasting God, who willeth not the death of the wicked, have mercy upon him through Christ, and grant him true and right repentance, that he may be delivered from the wrath to come. Amen. This the ancient canons call the greater ban, *excommunicatio major*. [...] After this renunciation and announcement of the ban, the sexton shall forthwith, before the communion or anything further in the church be begun, lead the excommunicated person publicly out of the church through the people, and let him go his way.

Public penance and absolution. A sinner who repented, whether before or after the ban, was first examined before the officer, the patron, the churchwardens and other honourable men. Five questions were put: does he confess his sin, is he sorry, does he desire forgiveness and public absolution, will he amend, does he desire the Supper.

On a communion Sunday the pastor then led him before the altar, where he knelt with two friends beside him. The rite has five parts:

1. An address to the people on the binding and loosing keys, naming the sin and the penitent's repentance.
2. The Lord's Prayer.
3. Psalm 67 (*Es wolt uns Gott genädig sein*) or Psalm 51 (*Erbarm dich mein, o Herre Gott*).
4. The five questions, each answered "Yes".
5. The absolution and readmission.

An exhortation to the people follows: they are to thank God, pray for the penitent, forgive the offence and never cast it up to him. The penitent then communicates. **Saxe-Lauenburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1585** (Sehling 5, p. 453):

Therefore I say hereupon to thee, as an ordained minister of Jesus Christ, in God's stead and on his behalf: Be of good cheer, my son (or daughter), thy sins are forgiven thee. We receive thee also again to be a member of the spiritual body of Christ, which is the congregation of his saints and faithful, from which body thou hadst torn thyself by thy vices, shame, sin and offences; that thou shalt hereby now be again incorporated into the same, in the name of God the Father, and of the Son, and of the Holy Ghost. Amen.

13.16.4 The Mecklenburg consistory order of 1570

The procedure. The Mecklenburg consistory order of 1570 gives the fullest Lutheran account of the procedure (its chapter "Of excommunication"). It begins from Matthew 18 and the rule of Deuteronomy 17, "judge with right judgement": a preacher must not only mean well but keep "a due and orderly process". The order distinguishes secret sins, which are to be rebuked in secret and never named from the pulpit, from notorious sins (*notoria facti* and *notoria iuris*). Grubenhagen in 1581 repeats much of this text word for word (§13.16.1). The steps are:

1. **Admonition.** The pastor admonishes the open sinner once or twice, alone or before two or three witnesses, warning that he will otherwise have to proceed further. A sinner who repents, even on his deathbed, is absolved without further penalty.
2. **Citation.** If he despises the admonition, the pastor reports him to the consistory, which is "the church" of Matthew 18: not "the common unlearned rabble", nor a pope or bishop, but "godly, Christian, learned, understanding men and elders" of all estates. The consistory cites him.
3. **Hearing.** He is admonished again and, if he denies the deed, convicted by two or three witnesses, or, if the case is one of doctrine, by God's word. If he then recants, he incurs no civil infamy, and the pastor announces his conversion to the church.
4. **Sentence.** If he still despises the consistory or fails to appear, he is named from the pulpit of his own parish and put in the ban by public sentence of the consistory.
5. **Execution.** The officer forbids him weddings, taverns and honourable company, but not his trade. He stands at a separate place in church at every sermon, and on communion Sundays the sexton leads him out through the people after the sermon and prayer.

6. **Absolution.** After a time of probation the pastor and officer report his amendment in writing; the consistory releases him and orders the pastor to reconcile him publicly on the next Sunday.
7. **Burial.** If he dies impenitent, the parish is not to attend his burial; he is to be buried "as a member cut off".

The form of excommunication. The pastor's address opens with a long exposition: God's unchangeable order is that men either obey his word or, if they sin wilfully and openly, are cursed; therefore God has commanded not only the magistrate to punish public crimes but the church to cast out those who despise its admonition. The pastor then names the sinner and the sin, rehearses the admonitions, and pronounces the sentence. **Mecklenburg, *Consistorialordnung*, 1570** (Sehling 5, pp. 245–246):

Now ye know how in this church N. N. hath hitherto spread abroad and defended public false doctrine and faction (or is an open, known manslayer, adulterer, whoremonger, usurer, drunkard). For which cause he hath been several times faithfully and earnestly admonished by me as his pastor, in the presence of two or three witnesses, and lastly also by the reverend consistory, to desist from this error or vice and to be reconciled with God and the offended church. But since he hath despised all faithful admonition and continueth defiantly and obstinately in his wilful disobedience against God's word and will, the reverend consistory hath resolved and commanded me to proclaim the same disobedient, obstinate seducer (when he is condemned for false doctrine) or sinner N. N., dwelling in this parish, on this present Sunday into the public ban, and to shut him out of this Christian fellowship of the church. Therefore I, as the common minister and pastor of this Christian church, in the name of our Lord Jesus Christ, do now deliver this impenitent, public (seducer, blasphemer, adulterer, whoremonger, usurer) N. N. unto the devil for the destruction of the flesh, that his spirit may be saved in the day of the Lord, when he shall turn again. I declare unto him herewith God's terrible wrath and displeasure, and that he is shut out and cut off from all fellowship of all saints in heaven and on earth, and cursed and eternally damned with all devils in hell, so long as he continueth in this impenitence. I deny him also herewith all rights of the church and the fellowship of all holy sacraments, save the hearing of the sermon. I beseech and exhort also all Christians that they have nothing more to do with this N. N., and withdraw themselves wholly from his company; not eat or drink with him, not ask him to stand godfather, not bid him to any wedding or other honourable company, nor greet him in the street or elsewhere; that he may be ashamed and humbled, and the sooner confess his sin and turn to God, and be reconciled with the Christian church, which he hath offended and scandalized in the highest degree by his disobedience, etc.

The absolution from the ban. On the Sunday appointed the pastor announces the consistory's release and bids the people pray. The excommunicate kneels before the congregation; the pastor says the public confession and the absolution "as is customary in our churches", and the act ends with the usual hymn. **Mecklenburg, *Consistorialordnung*, 1570** (Sehling 5, p. 246):

Dearly beloved in Christ, forasmuch as this N. hath hitherto for a time been separated, as an unprofitable member, from the holy Christian church because of his misdeed and obstinacy, and shut out from the holy sacrament of the Supper and from other honourable assemblies of the church; and hath since, by God's grace, behaved himself obediently, patiently and Christianly under this punishment, and hath also promised that he will henceforth by God's grace lead a Christian life without offence: therefore the appointed members of the consistory, after report received and inquiry made, have judged that the said N. is released from his church punishment for this time, as touching things past, and admitted again to the receiving of the holy sacrament of the Supper and to other honourable assemblies of the church. And ye shall all be warned hereupon diligently to pray that the almighty, merciful God will graciously forgive this N. and us all our sins through Jesus Christ, and endue us with the Holy Ghost, that we may lead a chaste and honourable life unto our death, through Jesus Christ our Lord. Thereupon the pastor shall say before the excommunicate, who kneeleth before the face of the congregation, the public confession and forthwith the absolution as is customary in our churches, and shall close the act of the church with the usual hymn.

13.16.5 Mansfeld 1580: discipline, the ban and open penance

The ban. The Mansfeld agenda of 1580 (chapter 19) records the agreement of the Mansfeld synod of 1562 to keep the discipline "which hath been customary in the churches of this county now many years". The ban is "the public separation from the Christian congregation and delivering to Satan of the impenitent and persistent sinners". As in Saxony and Mecklenburg, no pastor may proceed of himself: the consistory weighs the case, and if it resolves on the ban it commits the pastor of the parish and gives him a written form (*notel*) from which he may not depart or mix in his own feelings (Sehling 2, p. 241). The pronouncement follows Paul's words in 1 Corinthians 5.

Open penance without the ban. Chapter 19 defends the Mansfeld practice of requiring open penance not only from the excommunicate but from every notorious sinner, against those who called it defamation. Such sinners "are de facto in the ban,

though the church hath not yet shut them out", and what was sinned against all must be made good before all. **Mansfeld, *Kirchen-Agenda*, 1580** (Sehling 2, pp. 241–242):

But this also is to be known, that God in his Scripture maketh no difference between those publicly banned and other persistent and offensive sinners; for such are de facto in the ban, though the church hath not yet shut them out […] But now when a whole church and congregation is offended and scandalized by public sin and vice, how then can the begging of pardon and the reconciliation toward it be done otherwise than publicly? What hath been sinned publicly against all must surely be made good publicly toward all.

The rite of open penance. Chapter 20 gives the "process how those who do open penance are received again into the fellowship of the church":

1. A time of probation, to see that the repentance is earnest.
2. A day is appointed. After the sermon the pastor names from the pulpit, in the penitent's presence, his fall and sin, his conversion and his begging pardon for the offence.
3. The penitent kneels or stands before the altar, and the minister asks him publicly three questions: whether he confesses that he has sinned openly, angered God and offended many Christians; whether he is heartily sorry and desires to be reconciled by open penance with God and the offended congregation; whether he means by God's help to amend, and truly believes that for Christ's sake his sins are forgiven him by the holy absolution. He answers "Yes".
4. The public absolution, below.
5. An exhortation to the people to recognize their own weakness, "for whoso standeth, let him take heed lest he fall" (1 Corinthians 10:12).

Mansfeld, *Kirchen-Agenda*, 1580 (Sehling 2, pp. 242–243):

Absolution. God the Father of our Lord Jesus Christ, who hath brought thee to the knowledge of thy sins, and hath sworn: As I live, I will not the death of the sinner, but that he turn and live; he hath forgiven thee all thy sins for his dear Son's sake. And I, as an unworthy minister, in his stead and in his name, do also publicly and before this congregation here loose thee from the same, and receive thee into the fellowship of this his holy church, out of which thou hadst fallen; that thou mayest be governed by him with his Holy Spirit, and use with us others his holy sacrament profitably and worthily, to the strengthening of thy faith and the amendment of life, and be saved for ever. In the name of God the Father, and of the Son, and of the Holy Ghost. † Amen.

13.16.6 Grubenhagen 1581: the form of absolution from the ban

Grubenhagen 1581. Grubenhagen took over the Mecklenburg form of excommunication (§13.16.4) and added its own "form of the absolution from the ban and the public receiving of the penitent sinner into the congregation of God". The penitent has given signs of repentance on three appointed Sundays. The pastor addresses the people on God's mercy to fallen sinners (Adam and Eve, Aaron, David, Manasseh, the sinful woman, the thief on the cross), announces the consistory's mandate, puts three questions, and absolves with the formula of John 20:23. **Grubenhagen, *Kirchenordnung*, 1581** (Sehling 6/2, p. 1058):

Therefore I ask thee, N. N., whether thou confessest that by thy fall thou hast angered God, grieved many Christians and offended this church and congregation? Answer: Yea. I ask thee further whether thou desirest from thy heart to be loosed from the ban and reconciled with God and this church, and with every man, and beseechest this Christian congregation that it would forgive thee for God's sake that thou hast grieved it by thy fall and offended it by thy obstinate disobedience? Answer: Yea. I ask thee thirdly whether thou believest also the holy gospel, that God will forgive thee all thy sins for the sake of his Son and his precious merit, and that my forgiveness is God's forgiveness; and whether thou purposest henceforth to walk Christianly in such faith, to live honestly, and to remember this fatherly chastisement all thy life long, and to pray God that thou never fall into security? Answer: Yea. […] And I, in the stead and by the command of my Lord Jesus Christ, by virtue of his own true, eternal, unchangeable word, spoken out of his divine heart and mouth, when he said, Whose sins ye remit, they are remitted unto them, do forgive thee, N. N., herewith all thy sins, and proclaim unto thee God's grace, joy, comfort and eternal life, and that thou art received again into the fellowship of the Christian church; in the name of the Father, Son and Holy Ghost. Amen. What now is loosed on earth shall be loosed also in heaven, saith Christ.

The pastor then warns the people, "Let him that standeth take heed lest he fall", and forbids them to cast up the fall to the penitent or to think him of ill civil repute (*infamia*).

13.16.7 The Reformed form: Micron's London order

Micron's order (Reformed). The fullest Reformed rite is that of the Dutch stranger church in London, in Marten Micron's *Ordinancien* of 1554. Sehling prints it in the German translation used in East Frisia (1565). The procedure runs:

1. Private, then public admonition.
2. The sinner's name is announced twice to the congregation as a despiser of admonition.
3. A day is set, and anyone with objections from God's word has a week to bring them to the ministers and elders.
4. On the day, the morning sermon is shortened and the minister expounds the nature and end of the ban:
    - it is Christ's ordinance;
    - it punishes contempt of admonition rather than the sin itself;
    - the papal ban is void;
    - the power lies with the whole congregation, not with the ministers alone;
    - it is not contrary to love.
5. All the ministers stand before the congregation. The minister rehearses the case and asks his colleagues whether it is so; they answer "Yes".
6. All kneel for a prayer that God would break "the stony heart of our brother N.", followed by the Lord's Prayer.
7. If the sinner comes forward and shows true repentance, public penance replaces the ban. If not, the minister pronounces the excommunication in the form of a prayer to Christ.
8. The congregation is instructed how to treat him: as a heathen and publican, avoiding his company except in civil matters, yet seeking his amendment like a physician. Psalm 101 is sung.

The prayer of excision. Micron, *Ordinancien* (1554), East Frisian German edition, 1565 (Reformed; Sehling 7/1, p. 652):

we follow, O Lord Jesus Christ, thy holy commandment, and cut him off publicly as a rotten member from the holy body of thy congregation, and that with great sorrow of our hearts and compassion for his destruction. We bind here on earth his sins, and are assured out of thy word that they are bound also with thee in heaven. We cast him here out of thy blessed kingdom (that he may be accounted of all the faithful as a heathen and a publican), and give him by thy commandment to the devil for the destruction of his flesh, that his spirit may be saved; through thy holy name, who livest and reignest with the Father and the Holy Ghost, one only and eternal God, blessed for ever. Amen.

Readmission. The return of the excommunicate (chapter 26) follows the same pattern in reverse:

1. The elders visit him and examine his repentance.
2. A day is announced a week ahead, so that the congregation may "receive with joyful heart" the one it had cut off with sorrow.
3. On the day the ministers and elders stand beside him. The minister proves from Scripture that the fallen obtain forgiveness, and that "public offences require public reconciliation".
4. A prayer is said in which the whole congregation joins its sins to his.
5. He confesses and is received again (Sehling 7/1, pp. 653–655).

13.16.8 Other orders

The same pattern, with local variations, appears in:

- **Hesse** (Moderate Reformed). The *Ziegenhainer Zuchtordnung* of 1539 introduced elders, and its ban was pronounced before pastor and elders. The Hesse order of 1566 required the banned sinner to do penance "before the whole congregation which he had offended" (Sehling 8, p. 212).
- **The Palatinate 1563** (Reformed). Exclusion from the sacraments was to lie "not in the power of one or several ministers or other persons, but with a whole Christian congregation". Elders admonish three times and then separate the offender by forbidding the sacraments (Sehling 14, p. 388). Later Palatine ordinances add chapters *De excommunicatione* (Of excommunication) and *De receptione* (Of reception; Sehling 14, pp. 423–424).
- **Town of Brandenburg 1542.** A dissenting voice: the sacrament was to be refused to no one, since one whom God's word does not move will not be moved by exclusion; grave crimes belong to the civil power (Sehling 3, p. 255).
- **Couples who anticipated marriage.** The commonest public penance in practice was that of a couple who had lain together before their wedding. Nassau-Weilburg in 1609 required such a couple to do "public church penance" before they could be blessed, unless they had already been betrothed, in which case the fault was rebuked at the wedding itself; Hohenlohe in 1572 had both "set forth to public church penance and begging of pardon" (Sehling 10, p. 353; 15, p. 177).

- **Ysenburg-Ronneburg 1591 and Solms** (Reformed). Counts with Reformed leanings imposed "Christian ban and exclusion from the congregation" through a presbytery, with the magistrate's help (Sehling 10, pp. 596, 599; 9, p. 328).

Burial of the excommunicate. Burial followed the ban. Wittenberg 1542 ordered that the excommunicate be buried "not with song or ceremonies, nor in the common churchyard of the Christians, but in the field" (Sehling 1, p. 206).

13.17 Private confession and absolution

Auricular confession abolished, private absolution kept. Every evangelical order abolished the medieval sacrament of penance as a duty to enumerate all mortal sins to a priest, with satisfaction imposed. The Pomesanian articles of 1524 already ended confession "by which one would be bound to name all sins" (Sehling 4, p. 29). But the Lutheran orders kept, and generally required, private confession and absolution before communion. They kept it for three reasons:

- the absolution is the gospel spoken to the single person, "as if God by a voice from heaven promised thee grace";
- the pastor could examine those coming to the Supper in the catechism;
- the troubled conscience could be comforted.

Many Upper German orders replaced it with an examination of communicants (§13.17.4). The private and public forms of absolution after open sin and the ban are in §13.16.

13.17.1 The Lutheran position

Dietrich 1545: no enumeration, no compulsion. Veit Dietrich's Nuremberg agenda states the principle: the papal auricular confession is not commanded by God, and no minister may refuse absolution until the sins have been counted. It is enough that the person confesses himself a sinner and desires grace (Sehling 11, p. 528).

Saxony 1580: private absolution required before communion. The Saxon order of 1580 treats private absolution as a free thing, not a papal compulsion, yet requires everyone to present himself to his pastor and seek it before communion, "for the sake of Christian discipline and specially for the sake of the ignorant". **Saxony, *Ordnung* of Duke August, 1580** (Sehling 1, p. 427):

VII. Of right Christian confession and private absolution. After the pastor and ministers of the church have thoroughly taught the people out of God's word what is the difference between the papistical ear-confession, wherein people were tormented and forced to recount all their sins, which is impossible (Psalm 19), and the true Christian confession, wherein the youth are held to confession and account of their faith, every one is admonished of his calling in particular, but chiefly the faint-hearted, tempted consciences are comforted out of God's word in their heavy particular troubles: they shall diligently exhort the whole congregation thereto, and declare publicly that none shall be admitted to the most worthy sacrament of the body and blood of the Lord Christ unless he have first presented himself to his ordinary pastor and sought the private absolution.

13.17.2 The form of confession: Luther's catechism

The catechism form. The common form was the one Luther added to the Small Catechism, "How the simple shall be taught to confess". Many orders print it; the Palatinate under Ottheinrich (1556) gives it entire. The rite is:

1. The penitent: "Worthy, dear sir, I pray you hear my confession and pronounce forgiveness to me for God's sake."
2. A general confession before God of all sins, and a particular confession before the confessor of the sins one knows and feels, according to one's station under the Ten Commandments (a servant's, a master's or mistress's). One who knows of no particular sin is not to invent any, but to take the forgiveness on the general confession.
3. "God be merciful to thee and strengthen thy faith."
4. "Believest thou that my forgiveness is God's forgiveness?" "Yea, dear sir."
5. The absolution: "As thou believest, so be it unto thee", and the dismissal.

Palatinate, *Kirchenordnung* of Ottheinrich, 1556 (Sehling 14, p. 140):

Thereupon shall the confessor say: God be merciful unto thee and strengthen thy faith. Amen. Say: Believest thou also that my forgiveness is God's forgiveness? Yea, dear sir. Thereupon let him say: As thou believest, so be it unto thee. And I, by the command of our Lord Jesus Christ, forgive thee thy sins, in the name of the Father and of the Son and of the Holy Ghost. Amen.

Go in peace. But those who have great burden of conscience, or are grieved and tempted, the confessor will well know how to comfort with more sayings and to stir to faith.

The same form stands in the Lippe order of 1566, where the five catechism questions on the Supper precede it (Sehling 21, p. 379).

13.17.3 The form of absolution: Brandenburg 1540

Brandenburg 1540. Electoral Brandenburg gives a pastoral form in two parts, with the laying on of hands:

- **For the careless.** The confessor first asks whether the penitent knows the Ten Commandments. If not, he shows him that this is "the greatest sin a man may commit", to ask nothing after God, and bids him learn God's word.
- **For the contrite.** To one who confesses himself a poor sinner he says that this knowledge of sin is itself a work of the Holy Ghost, and explains that the absolution gives him in person the grace preached to all the world: "this word of absolution … thou shalt regard as if God by a voice from heaven promised thee grace and forgiveness of thy sins". Then he lays his hands on him and absolves.

Brandenburg (Electorate), *Kirchenordnung* of Joachim II, 1540 (Sehling 3, pp. 62–63):

After such instruction, if he desireth the absolution, let him speak to him with laying on of hands as followeth: Form of absolution. The almighty God and Father of our Lord Jesus Christ will be gracious and merciful unto thee, and will forgive thee all thy sins, for this cause, that his dear Son Jesus Christ hath suffered and died for them; and in the name of the same our Lord Jesus Christ, at his command and in the power of his word, where he saith, Whose sins ye remit, they are remitted unto them, etc., I pronounce thee free, quit and loosed of all thy sins, that they shall be all forgiven thee, as richly and completely as Jesus Christ hath merited the same by his suffering and death and commanded it to be preached through the gospel in all the world. And this comfortable promise, which I have now made thee in the name of the Lord Christ, receive thou with comfort, set thy conscience at rest thereupon, and believe firmly that thy sins are surely forgiven thee. In the name of the Father and of the Son and of the Holy Ghost. Go in peace.

Refusal. The same order tells pastors to refuse absolution and the Sacrament to heretics, blasphemers, open sinners and those who will not learn the commandments, the creed and the Lord's Prayer, until they show signs of amendment, and then to absolve and readmit them (Sehling 3, p. 63). The Saxon form for the sick of 1539 used the same private absolution, ending "Go hence in peace" (§13.8.3).

13.17.4 Without private confession: the examination of communicants

Upper German orders. Several south-western cities kept no private confession. In its place came the examination of communicants (*Verhör*), deliberately designed so that it could not be mistaken for auricular confession. Reutlingen, about 1531, had the children brought by father or mother, girls with the mother and boys with the father, to give account of their faith openly in church, "that it may not be suspected for a papistical ear-confession and snare of consciences" (Sehling 17/2, pp. 43–44).

Confession money abolished. The confession penny (*Beichtgeld*, *Beichtpfennig*) went with the old penance. Baden in 1533 relieved the people of stole fees "for confession, for the sacrament of the altar, for the holy anointing", and Hohenlohe in 1588 forbade pastors to take confession pennies (Sehling 16, p. 502; 15, p. 549).

The examination before first communion is treated in Chapter 15, §15.11.2, and general confession at the Mass in Chapter 3, §3.4.6.

13.18 Processions

What went and what stayed. The medieval church walked in procession constantly: round the church with holy water every Sunday, through the fields on the Rogation days and St Mark's day, with palms and the Palm-Sunday ass, with the sacrament on Corpus Christi, with relics, banners and crosses on patronal feasts and against hail and plague. The evangelical orders abolished the processions that carried the sacrament, relics or images or that invoked the saints, and almost all of the field processions. What stayed were processions that served the Word, prayer or common order:

- the funeral procession with hymns (§13.9);
- the bride's procession to church (*Kirchgang*, §13.7);
- the schoolboys' and townspeople's festal processions at Hof (§13.14.3);
- in Electoral Brandenburg and Mulhouse (Reformed), the Sunday procession, Palm Sunday and the Rogation prayers in a purified form.

Who walked in these processions and what was carried in them is set out in §13.18.4.

The fate of Corpus Christi, the Rogation days and the *Hagelfeier* (hail holiday) in the calendar is treated in Chapter 12 §§12.8.9 and 12.12.5.

13.18.1 Abolished

Pfalz-Neuburg 1543. The Pfalz-Neuburg order, following Brandenburg-Nürnberg 1533, put the abolition of processions at the head of its list of abolished blessings (§13.15.1). **Pfalz-Neuburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1543** (Sehling 13, p. 96):

Thereafter also all processions and goings about the church with the holy water and with the holy sacrament in the monstrance shall be left off.

Brandenburg-Nürnberg in 1533 likewise counted "going with the crosses" and "carrying about the holy sacrament" among the ceremonies done away (Sehling 11, pp. 203–204). A Feuchtwangen text of 1563 named the processions "with statues, banners, wooden crosses", the "impious pomp of the feast of Corpus Christi" and the carrying about of the Eucharist among the papal ceremonies (Sehling 11, p. 406). The Pomesanian articles of 1524 ended processions "as having no ground in God's word" (Sehling 4, p. 29).

13.18.2 Kept and purified: Electoral Brandenburg 1540

Brandenburg 1540. Joachim II's order is the great exception. It kept the Sunday procession round the church without holy water (§13.15.2), the Palm Sunday procession without the blessing of the palms, and the Rogation processions "before the church", purged of the invocation of saints; and it added a weekly German litany. **Brandenburg (Electorate), *Kirchenordnung* of Joachim II, 1540** (Sehling 3, p. 88):

Palm Sunday shall be kept with the procession and chants as of old, yet so that the hallowing of the palms be left off […] Of Rogation week. Whereas it hath also come down that on St Mark's day and the three days following the Sunday *Vocem jucunditatis*, and in some particular places at other times also, common prayers have been held for the church and other necessities, and holy St Paul, 1 Timothy 2, faithfully exhorteth us to pray diligently for the magistrates and others, it is also our mind that this so remain, as it hath come down from of old in Christian wise in every place and as the occasion of each will give, yet in all ways that pure and Christian chants, prayers and collects be used thereto […] Also the abuses that have been at such processions, with the invocation of the saints, shall be done away, and all prayers and chants directed to this end, that we seek all our need and concern from none other but the Lord Christ and ask help of him.

Mulhouse 1524 (Reformed). Mulhouse kept the Rogation processions on St George's and St Mark's days and the three Rogation days, but only within the parish church of St Stephen, "since the common prayer of Christians together is most pleasing to God", and without "running to particular saints or churches" (Sehling 20/2, p. 195).

13.18.3 Processions that remained

Funerals, weddings, festivals. The common evangelical processions were those of the life of the parish:

- **Funerals.** The body was fetched from the house and carried to the churchyard with the schoolboys singing, the minister and the people following (§§13.9.2–13.9.3).
- **Weddings.** The bride's *Kirchgang* (churching) with her maidens and the bridegroom's company to the church door or altar (§13.7); withheld from the bride who had fallen (§13.7.6) and from the divorced who remarried (§13.7.10).
- **Festivals.** At Hof the whole town walked in procession to the church dedication festival and to the school festival on Whit Monday, with wreathed schoolboys and hymns (§13.14.3).

13.18.4 Who walked and what was carried

The answer in brief. Where the orders describe a procession, the people in it are almost always the same four groups, in this order:

1. **the cross**, carried by a schoolboy or by the sexton;
2. **the schoolboys** with their schoolmaster or cantor, singing;
3. **the clergy**: the pastor (the "priest" or celebrant, who was also the preacher) and his chaplains or deacons, in surplices;
4. **the people**: men first, then maidens, then women; at a funeral, the mourners after the coffin.

No evangelical order names any of the following in a procession:

- **Persons.** A bishop or superintendent as such (at Hof the clergy walk as a body); a deacon or subdeacon with a distinct liturgical role; any of the minor orders.
- **Objects.** A thurible, incense boat, torches, candle-snuffer, crosier, mitre, canopy, banner, Gospel book, Bible or hymnal.

The only things carried in the evangelical processions are these:

- **the cross or crucifix**;
- **lights**, tolerated at Brandenburg funerals "with measure", and borne before the sacrament in Baden 1533;
- **the sacramental vessels** taken to the sick (§13.8.2);
- **the corpse** on its bier.

What the medieval processions had carried was abolished: banners, wooden crosses, statues, the Palm-Sunday ass, the Easter image, the monstrance, relics and holy water. The ministers of the minor orders analysed in Chapter 16 §16.4 had no place in any procession; their work was done by schoolboys and the sexton.

The order of march: Stendal 1541. The fullest description is the visitors' order for the Rogation procession at Stendal. The priests, schoolboys and people of each parish gather at seven in the morning, sing *Exurge Domine* (Arise, O Lord), and go in order to the Church of Our Lady, singing *Media vita* (In the midst of life) and then *Mitten wir im Leben sind* (In the midst of life we are). There a Mass or the office is sung and a sermon on prayer is preached. **Stendal, ordinance of the visitors of the Mark Brandenburg, 1541** (Sehling 3, p. 314):

[…] so that on the Monday in Rogation week the priests, scholars and people belonging to each parish church among you shall come together in the same parish church at seven o'clock in the morning, and first, before the procession, sing the antiphon *Exurge Domine*, and afterward hold the processions in order: as, first, to carry a cross before, thereafter the scholars, following them the priests, and after them the men, maidens and women; and the scholars and priests shall sing in the procession the antiphon *Media vita* in Latin, and when that is ended, then the German hymn *Mitten wir im Leben sind* […]

Funerals: cross, school, clergy, coffin. The funeral procession is the one procession found in nearly every Lutheran order (§13.9). Its order matches Stendal's. Electoral Brandenburg puts the cross first, then the schoolboys and then the priests, and leaves the old custom of carrying lights. **Brandenburg (Electorate), *Kirchenordnung* of Joachim II, 1540** (Sehling 3, p. 81):

In the leading forth of the body a cross shall be carried before, whereupon the scholars and then the priests follow. With some of old it hath also been customary to carry lights withal, and where that is in use, it may also remain with measure; and while the body is carried, they may sing *Media vita* and the three German verses *Mitten wir im Leben sind*, and if the way be too long, the German *De profundis* (Out of the depths), *Aus tiefer Not* (Out of deep distress), or else the responsory *Libera me, Domine* (Deliver me, O Lord).

In Waldeck the sexton carries the cross, and the schoolboys, schoolmaster and pastor walk before the coffin. **Waldeck, *Kirchenordnung*, 1556** (Sehling 9, p. 256):

Thereafter the priest goeth before the house of the departed, and the sexton or *Opfermann* (sexton) shall go with a cross, and next to him the scholars together with the schoolmaster and pastor, before the corpse; and in places where there are scholars, they shall sing a Christian hymn on the way, as by name: *Si bona suscepimus* (If we have received good things); item, *Aus tiefer Not*; or, *Erbarm dich mein, o Herre Gott* (Have mercy on me, O Lord God).

The same pattern recurs elsewhere:

- **Who carries the cross.** In Anhalt's order of the German hymns (before 1551) "a boy from the school shall carry a cross on a staff before the procession" (Sehling 2, p. 555); at Prenzlau "a cross shall be carried before by the scholars, which the

body followeth with the school" (Sehling 3, p. 261).

- **The pastor fetches the dead.** At Gottleuba the dead are fetched "with the school", and "a cross is carried before the corpse" (Sehling 1, p. 568). A Henneberg pastor reports, "I fetch the body with the sexton, scholars and cross" (Sehling 2, p. 342).
- **The crucifix.** Freiberg in 1538 required "a crucifix to be carried before at every burial, specially in honour of the high and comfortable article of the resurrection of the dead" (Sehling 1, p. 468). Wolfstein in 1574 allowed it "as a testimony on whom the Christians die, namely on the crucified Lord Jesus Christ", but called lights for the dead useless (Sehling 13, p. 586). Schwäbisch Hall allowed the cross "significatively, not effectively" (Sehling 17/1, p. 173).
- **Refused.** The impenitent were buried without bells, hymns, "cross-bearing, accompaniment or processions" (Schönburg 1542, Sehling 2, p. 175; §13.9.4).

What the clergy wore. The surplice (*Chorrock*) was the processional vestment. The visitors at Perleberg in 1581 required the pastor, chaplains and sexton to wear it at funerals "that they be not taken for craftsmen". **Perleberg, *Visitations-Abschied*, 1581** (Sehling 3, p. 256):

And forasmuch as the office of the curates of souls requireth, and it hath come down in Christian wise from of old, to commit the dead to the earth with customary Christian hymns, the pastor, chaplains and sexton shall therefore put on their surplices in accompanying the dead, that they be not taken for craftsmen […]

The Upper German orders went the other way. Amberg in 1555 left it free whether the ministers wore surplices "over the street", but the one who gave the exhortation was to wear his in church (Sehling 13, p. 294). Hohenlohe in 1590 told its pastors to accompany the dead "on the street or outside the town" in the plain church gown, not the surplice (Sehling 15, p. 622).

The Sunday circuit. Electoral Brandenburg kept the Sunday procession round the church, the *circuitus* (circuit), "with a pure responsory or other chant", without holy water (Sehling 3, p. 88; §13.15.2). The Havelberg visitors of 1558 show who walked in it. The pastor and chaplain lead it, the schoolmaster and his assistants sing, and the council and congregation follow. **Havelberg, *Abschied*, 1558** (Sehling 3, p. 232):

The pastor and chaplain shall diligently follow their calling in preaching, administering the sacrament and otherwise, [and] lay the cross together; likewise every Sunday and on high feasts hold the circuit with chants, according to the Christian church order of our most gracious lord aforesaid; and the council together with the congregation [shall] follow in good order.

(The phrase *das creuze semtlich legen* [lay the crosses together] is obscure; it may refer to setting down the processional cross.)

Entering the church and going to the altar. The only evangelical entrance rite is Brandenburg's: "the priest who holdeth the Mass, together with his ministrants, in their customary church ornaments, according to the custom of each church", goes to the altar and says the *Confiteor* (I confess; Sehling 3, p. 68). Elsewhere the minister simply "steps before the altar". No order describes a clergy procession at ordination or installation, beyond the new prelate being led to the altar by the prince's commissioners in Württemberg (§13.11.3).

Festal and civic processions. Two orders describe processions of the whole town:

- **Hof 1592.** On Whit Monday the clergy, the prince's captain and officials, the burgomasters, the council and the whole town gather in St Michael's. With the schoolboys, crowned with wreaths and the younger classes "clothed white in their christening shirts", they go round the high altar and out in procession to the convent church, singing *Veni Sancte Spiritus* (Come, Holy Spirit). The girls' schoolmaster with the girls and maidens follows the men, and the women come last (§13.14.3). **Hof, *Ordo ecclesiasticus*, 1592** (Sehling 11, p. 463):

On this day the reverend clergy, together with the lord captain and other princely servants, and also the burgomasters and council as well as the whole congregation of this town, are wont to gather in St Michael's church after the second peal has been heard; and from thence, with the company of the school (which, as soon as the bells are rung together, is found in the said church well adorned with fair wreaths [margin: NB. The lower classes shall be clothed white in their fair christening shirts and have on their hangings], goeth about the high altar and singeth the *Veni Sancte Spiritus* in plainsong [and] *Sei Lob und Ehr mit hohem Preis* [Praise and honour be with high praise] as far as the foremost great door toward the market), to go in procession into the convent church […] After the menfolk followeth the girls' schoolmaster with his schoolgirls and other maidens, and behind them the womenfolk in like orderly procession.

- **Strasbourg 1598.** On the Wednesday after the election of the new *Ammeister* and the oath-day, the whole magistracy with all the officers of the city went "in an orderly procession from the Pfalz into the Minster". There a sermon was preached on the office of rulers and subjects, followed by prayer for good government and thanksgiving for the past year. **Strasbourg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1598** (Sehling 20/1, p. 592):

That on the following Wednesday the whole magistracy, together with all that bear office, goeth in an orderly procession from the Pfalz into the Minster, where a special sermon is held of the office of the magistrate and of the subjects; and after the sermon is ended, the common prayer for a happy and peaceable government is made, and at the same time thanks are given to God the Lord [...]

The sacrament to the sick. The medieval sacrament was carried through the streets to the sick with a light and a bell, and the people followed. Feuchtwangen recalls how it was done "publicly by the parish priest, many following him" (Sehling 11, p. 406). The early Baden order of 1533, still on the old pattern, kept it. **Baden, *Kirchenordnung*, 1533** (Sehling 16, p. 510):

[...] that also this sacrament shall be carried about or over the streets with due honours, with light and bells going before, is shewn clearly enough in our gracious lord's former mandate, and there they let it rest.

The evangelical orders replaced this with the minister going to the house, with or without the sexton carrying the vessels (§13.8.2). Kronstadt in 1543 named what was dropped. **Kronstadt, *Reformationsbüchlein*, German version, 1543** (Sehling 24, p. 196):

Therefore it is resolved that the minister, without candles, bells and other pomp, which entice the unlearned to idolatry, shall go with them that have called him, with the bread and cup, to the house of the sick [...]

What was taken out of the processions. The orders that abolished the processions also cleared out what had been carried in them:

- **Images and dramatic figures.** The Palatine reform of 1546, following Pfalz-Neuburg 1543 (§13.18.1), did away with "all spectacles and plays that were made with images: on Palm Sunday with the ass, on Good Friday with the crucifix and the sepulchre, on Easter Day with carrying about the image of the resurrection of Christ, on Ascension Day with drawing it up, on Whitsunday with letting down the dove" (Sehling 14, p. 93). Feuchtwangen in 1563 lists "processions with statues, banners, wooden crosses" (Sehling 11, p. 406).
- **Relics.** Veit Dietrich asks the magistrate to abolish "setting out and carrying about relics" (Sehling 11, p. 550).
- **Banners.** The banners ended with the processions that carried them. Calenberg-Göttingen in 1542 abolished the "monkey-play" of running about in Rogation week "with the banners and saints", keeping the days with sermon, sacrament and litany (Sehling 6/2, p. 812). Teschen in 1584 forbade "the processions with the banners" (Sehling 3, p. 461). Leiningen-Westerburg in 1566 forbade carrying banners over the fields (Sehling 19/1, p. 227). Mecklenburg ordered its visitors to remove the banners and crosses from the churches. **Mecklenburg, *Visitations-Instruction*, 12 November 1552** (Sehling 5, p. 220):

[...] and in particular abolish unchristian ceremonies and idolatry, and also put away out of the churches the banners and crosses which in the papacy they were wont to carry about.

- **The treasures.** The processional crosses, monstrances, *viatica* (pyxes for the sick) and *pacificalia* (paxes) of the old processions were inventoried by the visitors and turned to the common chest (for example Grimma 1529, Sehling 1, p. 573; Zahna 1528, Sehling 1, p. 714).

Table of processions.

Procession	Who walks, in order	What is carried	Sources (§)
Rogation (where kept)	cross; schoolboys; priests; men, maidens, women	cross	Stendal 1541; Brandenburg 1540 (13.18.2, 13.18.4)
Sunday circuit (Brandenburg)	pastor and chaplain; schoolmaster and boys singing; council and congregation	— (holy water dropped)	Brandenburg 1540; Havelberg 1558 (13.15.2, 13.18.4)

Procession	Who walks, in order	What is carried	Sources (§)
Palm Sunday (Brandenburg)	"as of old"	— (the blessing of palms dropped)	Brandenburg 1540 (13.18.2)
Funeral	cross (schoolboy or sexton); schoolboys with schoolmaster; pastor and chaplains in surplices; coffin; mourners	cross or crucifix; lights (Brandenburg, "with measure"); bier	Brandenburg 1540; Waldeck 1556; Anhalt 1551; Prenzlau 1557; Freiberg 1538; Perleberg 1581 (13.9, 13.18.4)
Whit Monday and dedication festival (Hof)	clergy; prince's officers; council; wreathed schoolboys, younger ones in white; men; girls' schoolmaster with girls; women	wreaths and white shirts worn by the boys	Hof 1592 (13.14.3, 13.18.4)
Council procession (Strasbourg)	the whole magistracy and all officers	—	Strasbourg 1598 (13.18.4)
Wedding (*Kirchgang*)	bride with maidens, bridegroom with his company	the bride's wreath	§13.7
Sacrament to the sick	old: priest with light and bell, people following; new: minister alone or with the sexton	old: light, bell; new: bread and cup, corporal, surplice	Baden 1533; Kronstadt 1543; Hohenlohe 1553 (13.8.2, 13.18.4)
Abolished	—	monstrance, holy water, banners, statues, wooden crosses, the Palm-Sunday ass, the Easter image, relics	§§13.18.1, 13.18.4

13.19 Tonsure, deconsecration and the deposition of ministers

Rites of separation without rites. Three medieval acts marked a person or thing as set apart for God, or withdrew that mark: the tonsure, which made a man a cleric; the consecration of churches and vessels, and their execration when profaned; and the degradation of a cleric, which stripped him of his orders piece by piece. The evangelical orders kept none of these as rites. The tonsure was abolished as a human ordinance. Churches, chapels, altars and vessels were taken out of use by order of the magistrate and turned to the use of the parish and the poor, without any rite of deconsecration. A minister was removed from office by a public sentence, not degraded.

13.19.1 The tonsure abolished

A human ordinance. The evangelical orders give no rite of first tonsure and no clerical tonsure. The Albertine visitors at Freiberg in 1537 counted the tonsure among "all human ordinances hitherto held necessary" which "shall be done away": "ringing other than for divine services, going with the cross, wearing tonsures and cowls, fast days" (Sehling 1, p. 466). The Schleswig-Holstein order of 1542 lists "shaving the tonsure" (*Platten scheren*) with holy water, the blessing of bells, anointing and the separate holy vestments among the inventions of the papists (Sehling 23, p. 83). Bugenhagen reminded Hamburg in 1529 that St Lawrence "wore no tonsure nor deacon's robe, yet was a deacon, as is written in Acts 6 and 1 Timothy 3" (Sehling 5, p. 514).

Old-believing clergy ordered to let it grow. Where priests and monks remained, the magistrates forbade them the tonsure as a mark of the papal clergy. The Saxon visitors at the collegiate church of Altenburg in 1533 ordered the canons "to abstain from the offensive papal dress and tonsure" (Sehling 1, p. 515). Esslingen in 1532 (Moderate Reformed) laid a fine of ten florins on any chaplain or religious who had his crown shaved. **Esslingen, *Mandat für die altgläubigen Geistlichen*, 10 August 1532** (Moderate Reformed; Sehling 17/2, p. 371):

Likewise their honourable wisdom willeth that henceforth none of the same chaplains, nor the persons of religious orders, shall shave any more a crown or tonsure, but shall hold and show themselves therein like other Christian burghers, and so make or undertake no separation as was done in the papacy; and whosoever is found punishable beyond this, their honourable wisdom will punish him ten florins for every offence. […] Moreover it shall be told and enjoined upon all persons of religious orders to lay

aside their habits, and to shave the little crowns off their heads, and to show themselves in clothing like other burghers, on pain of the earnest punishment of an honourable council.

One later case. Sehling records that Heinrich Julius of Brunswick, postulated bishop of Halberstadt as a Lutheran child, received the first tonsure on 27 November 1578. It caused "great stir in Protestant circles" and was "sharply blamed by most", though Jakob Andreae called it an adiaphoron (Sehling 2, p. 464, editor's introduction).

13.19.2 Churches, altars and vessels returned to common use

No execration. The orders give no rite for deconsecrating a church or altar, and no rite of execration when a church was profaned. What they give are orders to remove altars, images and chapels decently and by authority, and to turn the material and the vessels to the use of the parish, the common chest and the poor.

Orderly removal. Strasbourg in 1525 (Moderate Reformed) forbade any burgher, cleric or layman, to remove or break "images, altars, panels, iron or stonework" on his own authority; anyone with a grievance was to bring it to the council (Sehling 20/1, p. 166). The Saxon visitors at Salza in 1540 ordered the council to clear the churches of their screens, candles, banners and images and of all altars but one, to put pews in their place, to close the minster and pull down a chapel, using its stone and timber for the bridge. **Salza, *Kirchen-Ordnung für Salza*, 1540** (Sehling 1, p. 654):

Therefore an honourable council shall cause to be cleared out of the churches and broken down all screens, candles, banners, idolatrous images and hindrances, and above all every altar save one, and the masonry which standeth before the choir in the Augustinian cloister; that in their stead pews may be made, and God's word the better heard and the administration of the most worthy sacrament seen. In particular the minster church of St Stephen shall be shut, and the chapel in Niederhofen pulled down, and its stone and timber used for the bridge and other necessities.

Württemberg in 1555 ordered the field chapels in which there was no preaching and no burial to be "broken down and razed", and complained that the duke still found them standing, and the little image-houses with their altars newly roofed (Sehling 16, p. 292).

Vessels and vestments sold. The surplus chalices, monstrances and vestments were sold for the common chest. The Schönewalde order of 1529 allowed the judge and jurors "to sell the superfluous chasubles and vestments profitably" for the chest (Sehling 1, p. 667). In the lordship of Homburg in 1605 the vestments, patens and chalices were to be sold, "one cup kept at each place", and all accounted for (Wittgenstein 1605, Reformed; Sehling 22, p. 149).

But not to profane use. The property itself remained God's. The Courland order of 1570 states the principle: what has once been given and hallowed to God's honour may not, under any pretext, be turned "to profane use", and its holders are to restore it (Sehling 5, p. 52). The Pomeranian synod of 1574 bade pastors see that church goods were not "transferred to profane uses" (Sehling 4, p. 490). The sacred character passed from the stones and vessels to the purpose they served.

13.19.3 The deposition of ministers

Removal, not degradation. No order has the medieval degradation, in which a bishop stripped a condemned cleric of his vestments and the instruments of each order in turn. A minister unworthy of office was deposed by sentence of the superintendent, synod or consistory, and the sentence was announced to the congregation. Wittenberg in 1542 removed from office a minister put in the ban (§13.16.2).

Hesse 1566 (Moderate Reformed). Hesse gives the fullest procedure, under the heading "How ministers of the church shall be removed from office". For negligence: admonition by the elders, then sharper warning by the superintendent, then sentence before several pastors or in the synod, after which the deposed man must leave the parsonage. For a public scandal: immediate inquiry by the superintendent with neighbouring pastors, and sentence whether the accused is present or not. In both cases the sentence is read in his church on the next Sunday by another pastor, who bids the people pray for a new minister. **Hesse, *Kirchenordnung*, 1566** (Moderate Reformed; Sehling 8, pp. 211–212):

If therefore a minister of the church maketh himself unworthy of the office by great negligence in his office, or by reason of open sins, as drunkenness, adultery, whoredom, theft, false swearing, sedition, manslaughter, heresy, schism or the like, it is truly needful that such a one be also publicly put out of his office before the whole congregation. […] This sentence pronounced by the superintendent shall be proclaimed on the next following Sunday by another pastor, on behalf of the superintendent or of

the whole synod, in the church wherein the dismissed man formerly taught, after the whole service in the church hath been performed. And at the same time those whom it concerneth shall be bidden to seek in good time after another, and meanwhile to pray God the heavenly Father diligently that he will send and give another, apt and diligent.

13.20 Sorcery and the cleansing of houses and things

This section asks whether the orders prescribe anything for cleansing a house, a church or an object that had been used in sorcery, witchcraft or the service of the devil.

No rite of cleansing. The orders give no such rite. No order exorcizes, sprinkles, blesses anew or reconsecrates a house, a stall, a church or a thing that sorcery or the devil had touched. The old means of cleansing were holy water, exorcized salt and blessed herbs and candles. The orders abolished them, and called them superstition and sorcery in their own right (§13.15, §13.20.1). Churches were neither dedicated nor reconciled (§§13.14.1, 13.19.2). What the orders do prescribe is:

- **prayer** in the house, without water or exorcism: Mecklenburg and Pomerania bless the house when the pastor visits the sick (§13.20.2), and Pomerania prays over the possessed (§13.8.7);
- **burning in public** for the tools of sorcery: charms, written blessings, blessed or bewitched objects and the sorcerers' books (§13.20.3);
- **breaking and burning** for the images, fonts and chapels of the old cult, which the orders call idolatry and rank with sorcery (§13.20.4);
- **guarding** the things of the sacraments, so that the baptismal water, the hosts and the altar could not be taken for sorcery (§13.20.5);
- **repentance** for the persons, or punishment: public apology and absolution, exclusion from the Supper, and the magistrate's penalties (§13.20.6).

The one reconciliation of churches. The only reconciliation of churches in the corpus is a Catholic one. In 1549 the Interim gave Strasbourg's collegiate churches back to the old clergy, and the bishop asked for the churches to be reconciled and their altars rebuilt and consecrated. The arbiters held that the reconciliation was unnecessary and might well be left undone. The chapters were to rebuild at their own cost the altars the Interim required. The bishop was asked to see to their consecration, and to the reconciliation if the law required it at all, which the arbiters did not believe, without offence (Sehling 20/1, pp. 369–370; §1.4).

13.20.1 The old means of cleansing abolished

Holy water against the devil. The medieval church cleansed houses, stalls and churchyards with holy water and drove off the devil and the storm with blessed salt, herbs and candles (§13.15.1). Bugenhagen's Braunschweig order of 1528 answers that these creatures were made to be used with thanks, not to take away sins or drive away devils. The more holy water there was, the more poltergeists. **Braunschweig, *Kirchenordnung*, 1528** (Sehling 6/1, pp. 389–390):

Now we know well whereto water, fire, lights, herbs and fruit are created and given us of God: that we should use them; not that a man should take away his daily sins with holy water and drive away the devils therewith (yea, the more holy water we had, the more poltergeists also); nor that a man should ward off the thunder with lights and herbs, and work sorcery with herbs in the bed and in the cellar by the beer. Beside that, all this is devised against the grace of our Lord Christ, who alone taketh away sin, and against the Christian prayer, wherewith we should call upon our dear Father through Christ in all our needs of body and soul. That helpeth in these matters, and no water, fire or herb; for such creatures are not created and given or commanded of God for such matters.

The devil's doctrine. The order then turns to water itself. **Braunschweig, *Kirchenordnung*, 1528** (Sehling 6/1, p. 391):

Water is a good creature, created us of God to wash, to cook, to drink, to quench, to cool, to bathe, to sprinkle, etc., that is, to use; for which we should thank God. Wherefore then should we set up a prayer, which yet were no prayer but blasphemy, that we might make the water into something else, for a use whereto God hath not created it […]: that the water (as they have taught and also used it) should serve us for the washing away of our daily sins, which they have called venial; to sprinkle and refresh the souls in the churchyard, which is a mockery besides; to drive the devils out of the house, and all evil from the swine and the cattle? Away, away with the devil's doctrines and works, which have darkened Christ for us!

The Nassau-Dillenburg order of 1537 asks the same question: where is the word of God that says that holy water "driveth the devil out of houses" (§13.15.1)?

The exorcisms of the creatures. The exorcism at baptism was kept in many Lutheran orders as a prayer over the child (§13.4). The exorcisms of salt and water, which made the holy water that was sprinkled to drive the devil from a place, were not kept. Thomas Stieber's instruction for Wolfstein keeps the baptismal exorcism, to be used "as a prayer" and not as "the sorcerers adjure the devil". It then turns to the exorcisms of the creatures. **Wolfstein, *Christliche Instructio* of Thomas Stieber, 1574** (Sehling 13, p. 578):

Herewith are meant also the exorcisms of salt, water, oil and chrism; for such exorcisms are godless, because such unreasoning creatures are adjured as though they were possessed of the devil. Moreover a special power and working is ascribed to them against God's word, as *the salt exorcized to put the enemy to flight*, as is found in the *Actus sacerdotalis* [the priests' handbook].

The editors give the usual form, which bade every wickedness of the devil's deceit and every unclean spirit flee "from the place where thou shalt be sprinkled" (*ab eo loco, quo aspersus fueris*; Sehling 13, p. 578, editors' note). The Transylvanian order of 1547 buries all such consecrations together. **Transylvanian Saxons, *Kirchenordnung*, 1547**, Latin version (Sehling 24, p. 225):

For the offerings for the dead, with the other ungodly traffickings, are driven out of the churches; and likewise let all the superstitious consecrations of divers creatures, the exorcisms, and the other works of heathen idolatry and of Jewish observances remain wholly buried for the time to come.

The hallowing is the defilement. Some people still ran to the Mass-priests and monks to have their wax, palms, candles and herbs hallowed. Leiningen's discipline order of 1566 forbids this, because these things were afterwards used for sorcery. It calls the hallowing itself a defiling and a profaning. **Leiningen, *Kirchenzuchtordnung*, 1566** (Sehling 19/1, p. 228):

XII. Of the hallowing of herbs. We forbid that any man henceforth run to the godless, superstitious Mass-priests or monks and let wax, palms, candles or herbs be hallowed, with which men afterward practise sorcery, charming and witchcraft; for all creatures are made and created good by God himself. But such defiling and profaning shall be wholly put down and forbidden, and so remain, on pain of ten gulden.

The Thüngen order of 1564 gives the same reason for abolishing the churching of women: it had bred "superstition and sorcery with blessings, St John's Gospel, hallowed waters, salt, herbs, candles and the like" (§13.5.1).

13.20.2 A house troubled by the devil: prayer

The blessing of the house of the sick. Two Low German orders give a prayer over a house. When the pastor went into the house of a sick man to give him the Supper, he greeted it with the greeting that Christ commanded (Luke 10:5), and the sexton answered. Then the pastor might say a prayer, in Latin or in German, that God would drive out of the house all the spooks, ghosts and power of the devil. There is no water, salt or exorcism. The prayer is said once, as the visit begins. Pomerania lets the whole form be shortened in a time of plague, when the pastor has many to visit, or when the sick man is near his end. The Mecklenburg order of 1540 and the Pomeranian order of 1542 have the same rubric and the same prayers (Sehling 4, p. 365). **Mecklenburg, *Ordeninge der misse*, 1540/1545** (Sehling 5, p. 158):

and when the pastor goeth into the house, he shall speak the greeting which Christ hath commanded: Peace be with this house; and the sexton shall answer: And with all that dwell therein. And the pastor may say this prayer in Latin or in German: *From this thy house, we beseech thee, O Lord, let the spiritual wickednesses be driven back, and let the malice of the tempests of the air depart; through our Lord, etc.* Lord, bless this house, and drive out of it all spooks, ghosts and power of the devil, that it, being thus hallowed, may be a dwelling for thee; through Jesus Christ our Lord. The sexton shall say: Amen.

The Latin collect asks that the spirits of wickedness and the storms be kept from "this thy house". The German prayer is a free version of it. It leaves out the storms, asks God to bless the house, and names what is to be driven out: the devil's spooks, ghosts and power. The house is to be hallowed by becoming God's dwelling.

Poltergeists are devils. No order in the corpus says how a house that a ghost haunted was to be cleared. The orders say what the ghost was. The "poltergeists" whose appearances had brought in the Masses for the souls were devils, and God forbids seeking the truth from the dead (Deuteronomy 18:11; Isaiah 8:19). **Braunschweig, *Kirchenordnung*, 1528** (Sehling 6/1, p. 428):

Poltergeists, which have been nothing else but devils, as is manifest, have made us many soul-Masses, which are not commanded us by God's word.

Hamburg in 1529 says the same of "the poltergeists, which are devils" (Sehling 5, p. 520). For a possessed person in the house, Pomerania in 1569 greets the house with "The peace of our Lord Jesus Christ be in this house" and resists Satan "with prayers and contempt" (§13.8.7).

13.20.3 The tools of sorcery burned

Württemberg and Hohenlohe: the sorcerers' books. The police orders of the princes deal with the sorcerers' tools. The Württemberg territorial order (*Landesordnung*) of 1552, which Hohenlohe took over almost word for word in 1558, bids the officials not to suffer sorcerers, devil-conjurers and charmers. Those who will not leave off are to have their books, and whatever else they use, burned, and are to be banished. **Hohenlohe, *Polizeiordnung*, 1558** (Sehling 15, p. 139):

we hereby earnestly command that all sorcerers, devil-conjurers, charmers and other such idolaters be not suffered in our lordship, but be earnestly held by our officials to leave off therefrom. But whoso, above such admonition, will continue in their idolatrous ways and will not leave off therefrom, their books, and whatever else they use thereto, shall be burned, and they themselves banished out of our lordship.

Where Hohenlohe has "their books", the Württemberg text has their *prillen*, their "glasses" (Sehling 15, p. 139, editors' note).

Castell and Hohenlohe: burned before the congregation. The Castell village order for Obereisenheim of 1579 fines those who resort to soothsayers, or who have themselves or their goods blessed or kept from harm with hallowed salt, wax, herbs and water. The hallowed or bewitched things and the written charms are to be taken from them and burned before the whole congregation, at the church or the town hall. Hohenlohe's police order of 1588 copies the article and has them burned "at the church" (Sehling 15, p. 580). **Castell, *Dorfordnung für Obereisenheim*, 1579** (Sehling 11, p. 691):

But if any man, whosoever he were, above such punishment and faithful warning, should run after soothsayers and take counsel of them about any things that he had lost, or that had otherwise gone against him; or should let himself or his goods be blessed under colour of physic, or be kept or healed with hallowed salt, wax, herbs, water and other sorceries or superstitious child's play: he shall forfeit unto us ten gulden without remission. And the hallowed or bewitched superstitious pieces and the written charms, where any of them be yet in being, shall be taken from him and burned openly before a whole congregation at the church or the town hall; for God hath forbidden us such superstition by Moses many times.

The article goes on to cite Leviticus 19:26 and 19:31, Leviticus 20:6 and Deuteronomy 18:10–11. Whoever still would not leave off was to be put in the tower on bread and water, "since God the Lord hath already hallowed and sanctified all things through Christ, without our word, cross, chant and self-devised ceremonies" (Sehling 11, p. 691). The Lippe order of 1571 deprives a sexton who wrote out St John's Gospel to hang about people's necks "for all manner of sickness and sorcery" (§13.12.2).

13.20.4 Images, fonts and chapels of the old cult

Idolatry beside sorcery. The orders put idolatry beside sorcery, as Paul does among the works of the flesh (Galatians 5:20). They dealt with the furnishings of the old cult as they dealt with the tools of sorcery: these were taken away, broken and burned, or turned to common use. The removal of images is treated at length in §§14.4.2–14.4.4, and the clearing of churches and chapels in §13.19.2. Three orders speak of breaking and burning. **Mecklenburg, *Processus visitationis*, 1552** (Sehling 5, p. 224):

But to the churchwardens command is given to put the ciboria and the altars, item the banners, away out of the church. […] And where it is learned that there is any idol or image which men were wont to worship, it is forthwith put away, broken and burned.

Sponheim 1566: the fonts of the "bewitched" water. The Front County of Sponheim was held jointly by the Elector Palatine and the margrave of Baden. When it was reformed in 1566, the Palatine councillors (Reformed) held that God's word commands more than the altars and idols to be broken down. They named the Mass vestments, the portable altars, the sacrament-houses, and the fonts "in which the bewitched baptismal water was kept". The joint chief officer and the Baden clerk objected. After a compromise the work was done in four villages, and the Palatines burned some of the idols, among them the images to which graces and indulgences had been tied. Baden then protested against "Zwinglian and sacramentarian image-storming". **Sponheim (Vordere Grafschaft), *Reformation in der Vorderen Grafschaft Sponheim*, 1566** (Sehling 18, p. 630):

item the sacrament-houses; likewise the fonts in which the bewitched baptismal water was kept; item the idols before which special Masses were read, and the fairer the idol, the mightier the Mass was esteemed: all which, together with other things that serve idolatry, God the Lord hath commanded in his word to be broken down and put away. […] of which [idols] some, and in especial the idols of grace and of indulgence, were burned with fire by the Palatines.

Transylvania 1607: burned, but by degrees. The Transylvanian synod of 1607 calls the idols "sure instruments of idolatry", which God commanded to be destroyed, broken and burned. It bids the pastors remove them slowly, out of the hearers' minds before their eyes. **Transylvanian Saxons, *Articuli de ceremoniis*, 1607** (Sehling 24, p. 493):

No less needful were this article also: that the idols should depart and be cast out of the temples appointed for divine worship, as sure instruments of idolatry, teachers of lies, and an adornment that becometh not the Church of God but that Babylonian harlot with whom the kings of the earth have committed whoredom. Wherefore also God commanded that they be neither made nor worshipped, but destroyed, broken, yea burned with fire. But since here also it is to be feared that we may effect little or nothing with the patrons of the idols, let us bear for a time what cannot be changed suddenly. Yet let the pastors strive to remove, by little and little and without tumult, the things which they see to be the tinder of superstition, and cast them out of the minds of the hearers before their eyes.

13.20.5 The things of the sacraments guarded

Water, hosts and the altar cloth. The sorcerers sought the church's own things: the baptismal water, the hosts and the altar. The orders do not purify these things after they have been misused. They keep them from misuse beforehand. **Wolfstein, *Christliche Instructio* of Thomas Stieber, 1574** (Sehling 13, p. 572):

Ninthly, the pastors shall take diligent heed that no sorcery be practised with the things that are used for the administration of the most worthy sacraments, as hath been done, and is yet done, with the baptismal water; or that some lay herbs or other things under the altar cloth, and have Mass said over them, and use such things for sorcery.

The water poured away. Grubenhagen in 1581 bids the sextons pour the baptismal water away at once, since sorcerers begged or bought it for their sick cattle. **Grubenhagen, *Kirchenordnung*, 1581** (Sehling 6/2, p. 1049):

Forasmuch as there are also found at times sorcerous, superstitious people, which misuse the baptismal water for their sick cattle, and beg or buy it of the sextons, the sextons shall, on pain of losing their office and of our earnest punishment, beware thereof, and for that cause pour away the water forthwith, and otherwise keep the fonts clean and neat.

The Upper Palatine visitors of 1579 had heard that some misused the baptismal water for superstition. They asked the sextons whether anyone begged it of them and where they poured it out, and gave them this order. **Upper Palatinate, *Visitationsordnung*, 1579** (Sehling 13, p. 317):

And it is thereupon commanded them: 1. That they give or let go the baptismal water to no one, under whatsoever colour it may be desired; 2. but pour it out as soon as the action is ended, on the churchyard or another clean and convenient place, without superstition.

Electoral Saxony in 1580 forbade the bell-ringers to sell the leftover water and the hosts, "which are afterward used for sorcery" (§16.7.1). The later orders count the communicants and consume what remains of the elements (§§13.22.3, 13.22.5).

13.20.6 The persons: repentance, not purification

Public apology and absolution. What the orders cleanse is the conscience. Nassau-Dillenburg in 1570 would not suffer sorcerers, soothsayers or charmers in the land. Those who ran after them and had their children, cattle and goods bewitched and blessed were to ask pardon openly before the congregation and be absolved. **Nassau-Dillenburg, *Visitationsabschied*, 1570** (Sehling 10, p. 113):

Likewise shall no sorcerers, soothsayers and charmers be suffered, but be punished according to the laws and banished out of the land. And they that join themselves unto them, run after them, take counsel with them, and after the warning given let their children, cattle and living be bewitched and blessed: they shall be held by their pastors, beside openly asking pardon before the Christian congregation for the offence they have given, to let themselves be absolved of their grievous sin committed; and they shall also be punished by the magistrate according to the matter and the person.

Exclusion from the Supper. The Transylvanian synod at Mediasch in 1595 barred from the Supper those who sought help in sickness from magicians and soothsayers. A pastor who did so was to be suspended from his office for a month before the elders of his community and fined ten florins by the chapter. **Transylvanian Saxons, *Synodalartikel gegen Zauberei* (Mediasch), 1595** (Sehling 24, p. 478):

Whosoever betake themselves to magicians and soothsayers, seeking of them help or any relief of sickness, ought to be deprived of the Lord's Supper.

Caution before the fire. The orders that treat sorcery as a crime leave its trial to the magistrate and the imperial law. The Solms order of 1584 punishes it "in body and life" (Sehling 9, p. 326), and the Burzenland articles of 1578 "with fire" (Sehling 24, p. 449). Two orders warn against haste. Hohenlohe in 1558 would have no court act on what a soothsayer said against anyone, since "the devil is nothing but a liar" (Sehling 15, p. 139). Count John VI of Nassau-Dillenburg ordered a secret inquiry into each person accused of witchcraft, before any arrest. **Nassau-Dillenburg, *Zaubereimandat*, 1582** (Reformed; Sehling 10, p. 175):

that in matters which concern body and life, and above all the salvation of the soul, men must not proceed lightly and upon a bare accusation, nor hasten to lay hold of anyone and imprison him before better inquiry, much less to the fire.

13.21 The litany, the suffrages and the bidding prayers at the Mass

What the orders inherited. The medieval rite knew three set forms of intercession besides the canon:

- the **Litany of the Saints**, sung in procession on St Mark's day and the Rogation days, and on Holy Saturday on the way to and from the font, before the first Mass of Easter;
- the **suffrages**, commemorations with versicle and collect, chiefly of the saints;
- the **solemn prayers** of Good Friday (*orationes sollemnes*): nine biddings, each with *Oremus*, *Flectamus genua*, *Levate* and a collect, for the Church, the pope, all orders, the emperor, the catechumens, all needs, heretics and schismatics, the Jews and the pagans.

What they made of them. The orders kept the first and the third in a new form and dropped the second. Luther's German Litany and his corrected Latin Litany (*Latina litania correcta*) of 1529 removed the invocation of the saints. They became the commonest set intercession of the evangelical churches: sung in place of the Mass when no one communed, inside the Mass, after the sermon, and on fixed weekdays, prayer days and Rogation. The Good Friday biddings survive in two orders. This section covers the Mass and the parish services that stood in for it; the Litany at the hours is in Chapter 10, §10.7.5. The general prayer of the church, including its bidding forms ("Let us pray for …"), is in Chapter 6 and is left aside here.

13.21.1 The Litany in place of the Mass

When no one communed. Where there were no communicants on a Sunday or feast, many orders replaced the Supper with the Litany. The Saxon visitors put it simply in 1529: "where there be communicants, the office of the Mass held; but where no communicants, the German Litany sung by the whole church" (Niemegk, Sehling 1, p. 616). Belzig (1529) has the Litany before the sermon (Sehling 1, p. 527), and Pomerania 1542 after it: "but chiefly let one read the Litany" (Sehling 4, p. 357). At Kempten (1553), on a Sunday morning without communicants, the people sing the Creed, the Our Father or a psalm, and two or three scholars then sing the German Litany, "the other scholars together with all the people answering" (Sehling 12, pp. 175–176). Pfalz-Neuburg sets out the whole service. **Pfalz-Neuburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1543** (Sehling 13, p. 77):

then shall the priest go before the altar, not in the customary Mass vestment, but in a cope or only in his surplice, and hold all things as is set above, as far as the common sermon. But after the sermon one shall sing the common Litany, with a collect *pro pace* (for peace), and then close with *Benedicamus Domino* (Let us bless the Lord) and the common blessing.

Mecklenburg made the Litany the whole of what followed the sermon. **Mecklenburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1552** (Sehling 5, p. 202):

When there be no communicants, it shall be held in all things with the singing and lesson before the sermon as is described above. Also in the sermon remembrance and exhortation shall be made, that men would come oftener to the communion, as is said. But after the sermon the Litany alone shall be sung.

Lüneburg 1564 repeats the rule word for word, adding the blessing and "Erhalt uns, Herr" (Keep us, Lord, by thy word) (Sehling 6/1, p. 553). Grubenhagen named the Litany as the successor of the old "prayer Mass". **Grubenhagen, *Kirchenordnung*, 1544**

(Sehling 6/2, p. 1033):

VII. Of the Litany, how it shall be held therewith. Every week, either on Wednesday or Friday, and on Sunday or holy days when no communicants are present, the parsons and their parishioners shall sing and hold the Litany, which aforetime was called the prayer-Mass; and before it a chapter or history out of the Bible, either out of the Old or New Testament, shall be set forth and read to the people as briefly as may be, for instruction and teaching.

The weekday "Mass" of the Litany. At Hof the weekday *Tagmeß* (day Mass) on Monday, Tuesday, Thursday and Saturday had no communion. It consisted of a hymn, a collect, an Old Testament chapter, the Litany, a New Testament chapter, a short hymn and the Our Father sung at the altar. **Brandenburg-Ansbach- Kulmbach, *Ordo ecclesiasticus* of Hof, 1592** (Sehling 11, p. 455):

The Litany, divided into certain parts, is sung by three or four boys of clear voice at the place where they otherwise read the Latin epistle on holy eves, with the face turned toward the choir; whereupon the other choir respondeth, as is customary.

The editor reports that the Litany was split into four, one part for each day, keeping the beginning and end every day. A petition for protection from "the Pope and the Turk" was added (Sehling 11, p. 455). It was dropped when there was a baptism.

Suffrages in the Mass without communion. The Transylvanian Saxons put the old suffrages in the same place. When no one communed, the Sunday service was a German psalm, a collect, a sequence or tract, and a New Testament chapter read in order to the people. **Transylvania, *Kirchenordnung* (Latin), 1547** (Sehling 24, p. 223):

The lesson finished, the Creed is sung, with the versicle and collect of the Holy Trinity. To this are added the remaining suffrages, for the king, for the remission of sins and for peace, with their versicles and collects, which likewise are ended with *Benedicamus Domino* and the blessing of the people. This office also is kept always in the same order through the whole year.

The weekday "high office … when no communion is celebrated" has the same Creed "with the aforesaid suffrages, collects and *Benedicamus Domino*" (Sehling 24, p. 225), and the German version says the same (Sehling 24, p. 245). At Bibersfeld near Hall (1535) the pastor knelt before the altar after the opening psalm and prayed the Kyrie in German and "the *preces publicae* for all needful estates and concerns" before the epistle (Sehling 17/1, p. 101).

13.21.2 The Litany within the Mass

Between the epistle and the gospel. The Litany could take the place of the sequence or gradual:

- the Albertine *Cellische Ordnungen* (Celle orders) of 1545: "at times, in the stead of the sequence, sing the Litany in German" (Sehling 1, p. 300);
- Prussia 1568: between epistle and gospel "one singeth the Litany, or on feast days one of the German spiritual songs of the feast" (Sehling 4, p. 83);
- Lüneburg, Regensburg, Mansfeld and Aschersleben, given in Chapter 8, §8.8.9.

Veit Dietrich gives the ceremony for the small towns. **Nuremberg, *Agendbüchlein* of Veit Dietrich, 1545** (Sehling 11, p. 498):

In the small towns, after the epistle, two or three scholars shall sing the Litany in German before the middle altar, and the other choir together with the people answer thereto. At the last sing the *Da pacem* (Give peace) thereupon, together with a collect *de pace* (for peace), as above.

During the communion. At Amberg the Litany filled a long communion. **Amberg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1550** (Sehling 13, p. 286):

The choir singeth during the communion "Jesus Christus, unser Heiland" (Jesus Christ, our Saviour), or "Gott sei gelobet und gebenedeiet" (God be praised and blessed) etc.; or, if the communicants be many, the Litany, and next the *Agnus Dei* (Lamb of God), and at the last the communion.

After the sermon. This was the commonest place. The Litany was sung after the Sunday sermon, before the communion or at the close of the service, at:

- Haderslev 1528, every Sunday "with the whole people … in Danish" (Sehling 23, p. 65);
- Mecklenburg 1552, Lüneburg 1564 and Pfalz-Neuburg 1543 when there was no communion (§13.21.1);
- Waldeck 1556 and many others.

Waldeck describes the posture. **Waldeck, *Kirchenordnung*, 1556** (Sehling 9, p. 277):

After the sermon certain of the scholars, or the parson, kneeling before the altar, shall sing the Litany as it is described in Dr Luther of blessed memory's little song-book, with clear voice and intelligible words, and the choir answer thereto. Thereupon the pastor shall close with a collect, as it standeth there, and the choir with the song, "O Lord God, give us thy peace", etc.

In Mecklenburg the pastor sang it from the pulpit. **Mecklenburg, *Verordnung der Visitatoren*, 1542** (Sehling 5, p. 149):

Thirdly, the pastor shall on Sunday after the sermon, in towns and villages, sing the Litany before the people from the pulpit with devotion, and the scholars or the sexton together with the people shall kneel down and answer him thereto.

On its prayer days Nassau-Weilburg (1576) closed the service with the Litany or "Erhalt uns, Herr" (Keep us, Lord, by thy word). Since the Litany covers "all needs that the Christian congregation has to lay before God", it was to alternate with the full set of prayers rather than be added to them (Sehling 10, p. 238).

Before the Introit. Regensburg 1542 and Transylvania 1547 put the Litany at the head of the service (Chapter 3).

Ordination within the Litany. Braunschweig-Wolfenbüttel ordained preachers on a weekday "after the sermon and the Latin Litany" (Sehling 6/1, p. 69). At Lüneburg the ministers went to the altar at a fixed petition of the Litany. **Lüneburg, *Kirchenordnung der Stadt*, 1575** (Sehling 6/1, p. 655):

When the appointed day cometh, the sermon is held, and in the Litany these words are sung, "O Jesu Christ, God's Son", then goeth the whole ministry with the ordinand before the high altar, and they kneel there all together, and the superintendent, or whoso shall administer the office of ordaining, beginneth to sing *Veni, sancte Spiritus* etc.

Ordination itself is treated in §13.10.

13.21.3 The forms and the singers

Luther's two Litanies. The orders name Luther's German Litany and his corrected Latin one, "as it is printed and gone forth at Wittenberg" (Calenberg 1542, Sehling 6/2, p. 812). The Latin Litany belonged to the school and the hours, and the German one to the congregation:

- Braunschweig-Wolfenbüttel 1543: the Latin Litany at the eve Vespers and at an ordination, the German "once in the week after the sermon, that the whole church answer" (Sehling 6/1, p. 51);
- Pomerania 1535: the Latin Litany at the boys' Saturday Vespers, and the German Litany once a week with the people (Sehling 4, pp. 340, 342).

Prussia had a Litany of its own, used at Regensburg (Chapter 8, §8.8.9). Marggrabowa insisted on Luther's prose text. **Marggrabowa, *Gottesdienstordnung*, 1581** (Sehling 4, p. 149):

Every Friday one shall sing the Litany as Dr Luther made it, and not in rhyme; and two or three boys shall kneel before the altar and sing, whereupon the chaplain shall make a short sermon without book.

Who sang it, and how. The usual pattern was two or three boys, kneeling before the altar or standing at the epistle place, with the choir and people answering. Nördlingen 1579 prints the Litany in two columns for alternating choirs, ending "Both choirs together: *Kyrie eleison. Amen*" (Sehling 12, p. 369). At Brandis in 1574 the Litany after the Thursday sermon alternated week by week between the sung setting "made by Doctor Justus Jonas" and Luther's (Sehling 1, p. 534). Where there was no school the Litany was read:

- at Limpurg in 1610 the town of Gaildorf sang it "before the altar", but in the villages the pastor read it from the pulpit (Sehling 16, p. 617);
- Zweibrücken 1533 allowed it "sung or read, as the place alloweth" (Sehling 18, p. 52).

13.21.4 The Litany days

Weekly. The Litany was most often fixed to a weekday:

- **Wednesday and Friday:** the Reuss articles of 1528, "in all ways to hold the Litany on Wednesdays and Fridays" (Sehling 2, p. 143); Grubenhagen 1544 (above);
- **Friday:**

- the Ansbach chapters 1533 (Sehling 11, p. 314);
- Mecklenburg 1542, where the people were "to help the scholars sing" it, "as is held on Sunday" (Sehling 5, p. 149);
- Marggrabowa 1581 (above);
- Nördlingen 1579, "commonly on Friday after the sermon" (Sehling 12, p. 369).

The calendar of prayer days, Ember days and fasts on which the Litany was sung is set out in Chapter 12, §§12.6.2, 12.10.11, 12.12.7. That chapter gives the Albertine Ember-week Litany (Saxony 1539) and the Zweibrücken prayer days. Mansfeld (1580) wanted the German Litany "often and much, especially on the four Ember seasons, when the people are together" (Sehling 2, p. 239).

Rogation. The Litany kept its oldest home in Rogation week, without the procession and the saints. Calenberg 1542 abolished the procession but kept the prayer days "with preaching, administering the sacrament, and the Litany early in the morning". **Calenberg-Göttingen, *Kirchenordnung*, 1542** (Sehling 6/2, p. 812):

But the Litany shall be held, not as in former times, when men sang *Sancte Petre, ora pro nobis!* (Saint Peter, pray for us!), but after the manner and measure in which it is printed and gone forth at Wittenberg.

Elsewhere at Rogation:

- the Heidelberg chapter in 1546 was to sing "no litany *in rogatoribus* with invocation of the saints, but the right Litany with invocation of the name of God" (Sehling 14, p. 92);
- Brandenburg 1572 preaches "of prayer" through Rogation week and sings the Litany (Sehling 3, p. 102).

Pomerania 1569 gives the whole week the Litany and a penitential character. **Pomerania, *Agenda*, 1569** (Sehling 4, p. 466):

Therefore one shall preach on this Sunday and the following week, save the day of the Ascension of the Lord, of holy prayer, and sing the Litany, and earnestly exhort the congregation that every one go diligently to church and keep his household to prayer. […] On this Sunday and in the week one shall sing no figured song, nor play the organ, except the day of the Ascension of the Lord with its vigil, but sing only German psalms, prayer-psalms, penitential psalms, the Our Father etc., [and] always hold the Litany beside the sermon.

13.21.5 The Litany at the feasts and seasons

Advent and Lent. In Pomerania the Litany marked the penitential seasons. In Advent the village pastors were to read Matthew 24–25 at the Friday or weekday sermon "and thereupon hold the Litany" (Sehling 4, p. 471). The Latin Litany replaced the *Magnificat* when Vespers were kept "*dominicaliter*, as in Advent and Lent" (Pomerania 1542; Chapter 10, §10.7.5).

The high feasts. Several orders tie the Litany to the great feasts. Zweibrücken is the earliest. **Pfalz-Zweibrücken, *12 Artikel "Form und Maß"*, 1533** (Sehling 18, p. 52):

It were also good that about four times in the year, as in the Christmas, Easter and Whitsun weeks and after the Exaltation of the Cross, a Christian Litany were sung or read, according to the circumstances of the place.

Two later witnesses follow:

- **Pfalz-Veldenz 1574** made the two days after Christmas, Easter and Whitsun "common prayer days", with preaching in the morning only and the Litany sung or read after the sermon (Sehling 18, p. 519; Chapter 12, §12.6.2).
- **Danzig.** A list of feast days printed by Sehling as a draft for the order of 1567 names the feasts "with several Masses, Vespers, litanies through the choir, and four sermons". These are the Sundays, Trinity, Easter, Whitsun and Christmas with the two days following, and the other high feasts (Sehling 4, p. 186).

Easter Eve and Easter Day: a negative. No order puts a Litany on Easter Eve, before or after the font, or on Easter Day itself. The medieval Holy Saturday Litany went with the blessing of the font and the Easter candle, which nearly all the orders gave up (§13.23.5). The Easter Litany survives only in the Easter-week prayer days of Zweibrücken and the "litanies through the choir" of the Danzig feast list. No Sehling order has a Litany sung at an Easter Vigil.

13.21.6 Good Friday: the Litany and the solemn prayers

The Litany on Good Friday. Two southwestern orders make the Litany the intercession of the day. **Schwäbisch Hall, *Kirchenordnung*, 1543** (Sehling 17/1, p. 166):

And if communicants be present, the Supper shall be held on Maundy Thursday and Good Friday as on the Sundays, yet with a sermon going before. There shall also on Good Friday be a sermon made of the common prayer, and the Litany held for all the concerns of the Christian church.

The revision of 1615 keeps it: on Good Friday the communion "with a sermon going before on prayer, whereupon the Litany shall be sung" (Sehling 17/1, p. 165). Limpurg (1610) has the pastors on Good Friday "read the Litany together with the prayer" (Sehling 16, p. 621). The choice is deliberate: a sermon on prayer and the Litany, which prays for all estates, take the place of the old solemn prayers for all orders of men.

The solemn prayers in German: Waldeck 1556. Only Waldeck kept the solemn prayers as a set of biddings and collects. They were to be used "in all churches on Good Friday before the communion" (§13.23.4). The order prints them in full as *Precationes solennes pro singulis ordinibus et necessitatibus die Parasceues dicendae* (Solemn prayers for every order and need, to be said on Good Friday; Sehling 9, pp. 277–282). Each has a Latin heading, a German bidding addressed to the people ("We will also pray for …" or "Let us also pray for …"), and an *Oratio* (Prayer). There are eleven intentions:

1. the Church;
2. *pro ministris verbi et ecclesiae* (for the ministers of the word and the church);
3. *pro catechumenis* (for the catechumens);
4. *pro errantibus in fide* (for those that err in the faith);
5. *pro persecutoribus Verbi et Ecclesiae* (for the persecutors of the Word and the Church);
6. *pro magistratibus* (for the magistrates);
7. *pro iudaeis* (for the Jews);
8. *pro pseudochristianis* (for false Christians);
9. *pro inimicis* (for enemies);
10. *pro tentatis et sub cruce laborantibus* (for the tempted and those labouring under the cross);
11. *pro peccatis nostris* (for our sins).

They open with an address to the "dear brothers and sisters" and Christ's promise to those who ask. **Waldeck, *Kirchenordnung*, 1556** (Sehling 9, p. 278):

Since we are now gathered in the name of the Lord, let us first pray from the heart for the congregation of the Christian Church, that Almighty God through our Lord Jesus Christ will protect and preserve it in all the world, that it may live in rest and peace according to his divine will, and laud and praise his holy name.

The bidding for the Jews keeps the old intention but drops the old language of "perfidy" and "blindness" for the veil of 2 Corinthians 3 and the olive tree of Romans 11. **Waldeck, *Kirchenordnung*, 1556** (Sehling 9, p. 280):

For the Jews. Let us also pray for the wretched remnant of the seed of the Jews, that the merciful God would graciously awaken in their hearts his old promise, and take away the veil from before their eyes and hearts, that they also may come to the knowledge of Jesus Christ our Lord. Prayer: Merciful, kind God, who shuttest not out even the hardness of the Jews from thy mercy, remember thy gracious covenant which thou didst set up with thy faithful servant Abraham and with other dear fathers.

What changed from the Roman order.

- *Kept*: the Church, the clergy, the catechumens, the rulers, those in error, the Jews, and the afflicted. The Roman "all needs" becomes "the tempted and those labouring under the cross", with a long list: hunger, pestilence, wild beasts and the sword, prisoners, exiles, the sick, widows and orphans, and women in childbirth.
- *Dropped*: the pope; the pagans; the *Flectamus genua* and *Levate*. The people are bidden, but no kneeling and rising is prescribed.
- *Added*: persecutors of the word, false Christians, enemies, and our own sins.

Mülhausen 1528 (Reformed). The Mülhausen preachers had earlier kept the Roman prayers in German, "the collects which are prayed for the estates, namely for heathen, Turks, Circassians and Jews" (Sehling 20/2, p. 207; §13.23.4).

What was not found. No other order prints or prescribes the Good Friday solemn prayers. No order has *Flectamus genua* or *Oremus, dilectissimi*, and no order keeps the prayer *pro perfidis Iudaeis* (for the faithless Jews). Elsewhere the Good Friday intercession was the Litany, or the ordinary general prayer after the Passion sermon.

13.22 Other occasional rites

13.22.1 The visitation service

Pfalz-Neuburg 1560. The church visitation was the evangelical substitute for the bishop's visitation. At the parish level it had its own service. Pfalz-Neuburg's visitation order of 1560/1566 describes it:

1. Two stanzas of *Nun bitten wir den Heiligen Geist* (Now pray we the Holy Ghost).
2. The public confession.
3. The last two stanzas (*Du süße Lieb, schenk uns deine Gunst*, Thou sweet love, grant us thy favour).
4. A collect, the epistle and the Creed (*Wir glauben all*).
5. A short sermon by the pastor.

One of the visitors then addresses the people in the prince's name. The youth are examined in the catechism in church, boys and men-servants on one side and girls and maids on the other. A second address follows, rebuking parents and masters for negligence, and the newly appointed censors are presented by name. **Pfalz-Neuburg, *Visitationsordnung*, 1560/1566** (Sehling 13, p. 140):

First, when the people are gathered, they sing two stanzas of the hymn *Nun bitten wir den Heiligen Geist*. Thereafter the public confession is read. Thirdly they sing the last two verses, *Du süße Lieb, [schenk uns] dein Gunst* (Thou sweet love, [grant us] thy favour); and thereupon followeth a collect, upon the collect the epistle, and after the epistle the Creed is sung. After the Creed the pastor maketh a short sermon. After the sermon is held, one of the visitors addresseth the people after this manner following.

13.22.2 Rites treated in other chapters

Some occasional services are treated elsewhere, or only touched on here:

- **Prayer days and fast days.** Days of prayer against the Turk, plague, dearth and war, and the litany days, are in Chapter 12.
- **Private confession and absolution.** Confession before communion is outside the scope of this chapter; its relation to public penance is noted in §13.16.1 and §13.16.3.
- **Confessional oaths.** The oaths sworn by ministers, schoolmasters and church officers at ordination, installation and visitation are in Chapter 17.

13.22.3 Reservation of the sacrament

§13.8.2 shows the orders ending the carrying of the reserved sacrament to the sick. This section gathers what they say about reservation as such: keeping consecrated hosts after the service, whether for the sick, for later communicants or for adoration.

Kept for the sick and for later communicants: Ansbach 1526. One early Franconian decree still keeps the reserved sacrament. The diet of 1526 orders "all due reverence" to the sacrament in church and when it is carried to the sick through the streets. Whatever is left over after communion is not to be thrown away but kept reverently in the sacrament house for the sick and for other communicants. **Brandenburg-Ansbach-Kulmbach, *Landtagsabschied*, 1526** (Sehling 11, p. 91):

but [that] to this holy sacrament, in the churches and when it is carried to the sick over the streets, all due reverence be done [...] And if at the times and days when the communicants receive the holy, most worthy sacrament, aught of the sacrament remained over, the same shall not be put away contemptuously, but kept with due reverence in the sacrament houses, for the keeping [of it] for the sick that daily fall in, or for other communicants.

A free thing, to be given up: Nuremberg 1528. Two years later the Nuremberg theologians treated reservation as one of the "free things". Osiander's answer is that it is free, but that since it serves neither faith nor love it should be given up, after teaching, where the weak are not offended. **Nuremberg, *Die Nürnberger 23 Lehrartikel*, 1528** (Sehling 11, p. 134):

Whether one should lock up the sacrament? [...] Answer: It is also free. Therefore one should do what is most profitable, that is: where it offendeth not the weak, one should, after good instruction, leave it off and put it away; for it serveth neither faith nor love, etc.

The Brandenburg-Nürnberg church order of the same year gives the reasons. Christ commanded the body and blood to be eaten and drunk, not locked up or carried about. The wine would spoil sooner than the bread. The sacrament can be consecrated in the presence of the communicants whenever it is needed. **Brandenburg-Nürnberg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1528** (Sehling 11, p. 138):

Of the locking up of the sacrament. Item, since we have command from the word of God only to eat and drink the body and blood of Christ, and not to lock them in little houses nor carry them about; also such sacrament in the wine would spoil sooner than in the bread, if it stood long; and in such locking up there is no profit at all, but much offence followeth therefrom; and it shall and may be consecrated in the presence of the communicants: such locking up and carrying about of this sacrament is to be left off. Yet so, that this be first set right with the word.

The great Brandenburg-Nürnberg order of 1533 makes it a rule: "they shall not keep, lock up nor carry about the holy sacrament" (Sehling 11, p. 184; §13.8.2). Hohenlohe 1553, Wolfstein 1574 and the Merseburg synod of 1544 say the same (§13.22.5).

Old hosts not to be used: Transylvania 1547. The church order of the Transylvanian Saxons forbids a priest to give communion from hosts consecrated long before and kept "in corners", without saying the words of the testament. Christ said "take, eat, drink", not "put it in a corner, lock it fast, serve it with candles and lamps". **Transylvanian Saxons, *Kirchenordnung* (German version), 1547** (Sehling 24, p. 235):

6. Neither shall one suffer hereafter that the priest leave out the words of the holy testament and would use the particles which, after a private blessing, against the ordinance of Christ, he hath kept shut up in corners for some time. [...] 7. Therefore let no one out of unbelief use such leftover consecrated particles in such wise for communicating, or lock them up anywhere to offence and practise idolatry therewith. For Christ saith: Take, eat, drink and do this. But he saith nowhere: Set it in a corner, lock it fast, serve it with candles and lamps, and carry it about walking in processions.

The Latin version of the same order has the same rule (Sehling 24, p. 214).

Forbidden late: Teschen 1584. In the Silesian duchy of Teschen the custom was still alive in the villages in 1584. The order forbids the adoration of the sacrament, locking it "in the ciborium, as they call it", processions with banners, and the Holy Week sepulchre. **Teschen, *Kirchenordnung*, 1584** (Sehling 3, p. 461):

Since also at the Mass and otherwise hitherto, especially in the villages, many idolatrous ceremonies have been held and are still held, as the adoration of the sacrament, the locking up of the sacrament in the ciborium, as they call it, the processions with the banners and other such idolatry more, especially the idolatrous abuse in Holy Week with making the sepulchre and singing before the sepulchre: this shall all be wholly and earnestly forbidden and done away herewith.

No reservation for the next service. No Lutheran order after Ansbach 1526 allows hosts to be kept from one celebration to the next. The orders instead count the communicants beforehand so that only enough is consecrated (§13.22.5).

Veil, lamp and colour. No order says anything about veiling the reserved sacrament, the ciborium or the pyx, or about the colour of a lamp, its glass or its candle. The lamp before the sacrament house appears only to be forbidden: Schönburg 1542 lets no sacrament be kept in the sacrament house "nor suffer burning lamps before it" (Sehling 2, p. 175). The Transylvanian order rejects serving the hidden hosts "with candles and lamps" (above). The lights that remain are those set on the table at a sick-communion in the house (§13.8.2).

13.22.4 Good Friday: no Mass of the Presanctified

The medieval Good Friday rite gave communion, to the priest alone, from a host consecrated on Maundy Thursday and kept overnight at an altar of repose or in the Easter sepulchre. No evangelical order keeps the Mass of the Presanctified or an altar of repose. The orders either hold a full communion on Good Friday, consecrated like any other, or none.

Communion as on a Sunday. Bugenhagen's Brunswick order lets those who wish to commune after the Good Friday Passion do so "as is customary on Sunday after the sermon". There is no sung Mass and no ceremony before the sermon, because the

Passion preached is a good ceremony for communicating. **Brunswick, *Kirchenordnung*, 1528** (Sehling 6/1, p. 379):

If any after the Passion on Good Friday will communicate, let the sacrament be given as is the custom on Sunday after the sermon, although on that day the Mass-singing and ceremony is not held before the sermon. The Passion preached is a good ceremony for communicating. For Christ saith: This do in remembrance of me, that is, as Paul saith, shew forth my death, etc.

Hamburg 1529 repeats the passage word for word (Sehling 5, p. 506). At Rostock about 1560 the Good Friday service ends with communion. **Rostock, *Conformitas ceremoniarum*, about 1560** (Sehling 5, p. 290):

On Good Friday one shall read the history of the Passion of Christ to the people from five to six, according to the evangelists. Thereafter there is singing at seven and the office held; from seven to nine there is preaching, and thereafter the communion held.

Electoral Brandenburg in 1540 kept the Good Friday office with "the representation of the burial", but required "a complete consecration and administration of the sacrament" within it (§13.23.3). The Brandenburg order of 1572 has the Passion read at four in the morning "as of old", then "the sermon and communion" (Sehling 3, p. 102, from the editor's apparatus to the order of 1540). Waldeck 1556 has the solemn prayers of Good Friday said "before the communion" (Sehling 9, p. 277). The Hof order of 1592 provides music "under the communion" on Good Friday (Sehling 11, p. 439).

The sepulchre abolished. The burial of the cross or host in the Easter sepulchre, with its watch until Easter morning, went with the rest. Mülhausen in 1528 (Reformed) asks that "the burial of the Lord in the sepulchre, with other uses, be put down" (Sehling 20/2, p. 207; see Chapter 14, §14.6.6). Nuremberg reported to Goslar that "the sepulchre in the church" was no longer set up. **Goslar, *Bericht der Stadt Nürnberg für den Goslarer Rat*, 30 March 1528** (Sehling 7/2.2, p. 232):

The juggling-play with the Lord-God and the ass on Palm Sunday, the Passion plays on Good Friday are no more played; the sepulchre in the church, the mockery with the resurrection of Christ, is no more undertaken; likewise the fire on Easter Eve is no more blessed.

The Feuchtwangen memorial of 1563 recalls the reformers rejecting "on Good Friday the laying of the cross in the sepulchre, and the watches that followed" (Sehling 11, p. 406), and Teschen in 1584 still had to forbid "making the sepulchre and singing before the sepulchre" (§13.22.3).

13.22.5 The remaining elements consumed

Since nothing was to be reserved, the orders had to say what became of consecrated bread and wine left after communion. They answer in three ways: count the communicants so that little or nothing is left; have the minister or the communicants consume the rest; and never mix it back with unconsecrated bread and wine, pour it away or give it to the sexton.

Consumed by the priest or the communicants: Merseburg 1544. Merseburg, *Synodalunterricht*, 1544 (Sehling 2, p. 18):

They shall also not use the most worthy sacrament in any other way outside the institution of Christ, nor carry it about nor set it in [the sacrament house]. When also aught of the particles or in the cup remaineth over, it shall not be set aside or poured away, but be fully consumed by the priest or the communicants who have partaken of the meal of the sacrament.

All distributed and used up: Pfalz-Neuburg 1543. Pfalz-Neuburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1543 (Sehling 13, p. 76):

And although from the beginning he shall be diligent so to order and have regard to all things that naught of the holy sacrament remain over, yet at the end especially he shall see to it that it be all distributed and used up, as Christ commanded when he saith, Luke 22 [17]: *Dividite inter vos* (divide it among you), that no grievous or offensive unseemliness befall.

The pastor consumes the remains: Hohenlohe 1553. Hohenlohe, *Kirchenordnung*, 1553 (Sehling 15, p. 72):

The pastor shall then consume the remains and let nothing remain over or be reserved; and he shall also have special heed in the administration of both parts of the sacrament, that no mishap befall the sacrament in the spilling of the cup, etc.

The pastor communes, and so takes the remains: Wolfstein 1574. Thomas Stieber wants pastors always to commune with their people, for the example, and also so that the remains are consumed and nothing reserved. **Wolfstein, *Christliche Instructio des Thomas Stieber*, 1574** (Sehling 13, p. 575):

It is therefore good that the pastors always communicate with [the people], for the example's sake. So it serveth also for good order, that the remains of the sacrament be taken by the minister and naught of the holy sacrament need be kept.

Regensburg [1567] has the officiant commune last "and take what is left of the consecrated there" (Sehling 13, p. 463). The Danzig order of 1557, as Sehling describes it, wants everything blessed "to be used up cleanly, without leftover spilling or setting aside" (Sehling 4, p. 169).

Not mixed back with common bread and wine: Lüneburg 1575. Lüneburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1575 (Sehling 6/1, p. 660):

If also after communion is done aught of the bread or wine remaineth over, the same is not put back again to the other common bread or wine, nor set away, but is partaken of by the minister who performeth the office, or given to the other communicants as occasion serveth.

Not left to the sexton: Nuremberg 1545. Veit Dietrich asks communicants to announce themselves so that the pastor knows how much to consecrate. "This disorder is fit in no wise", he says, that wafers and wine be carried to the altar without measure "and then the rest left to the sexton for his use at home". **Nuremberg, *Agendbüchlein* of Veit Dietrich, 1545** (Sehling 11, p. 531):

For this disorder is fit in no wise, that one should carry wafers and wine to the altar without certain measure, and thereafter would leave the rest to the sexton to use for his need in the house.

Württemberg 1536 likewise counts the bread by the number of communicants and measures the wine "so that at the last nothing remain in the cup" (Sehling 16, p. 107). The Limpurg visitors of 1611 still asked each pastor whether he consecrated more hosts than there were communicants, and what he did with any left over (Sehling 16, p. 629).

The Melanchthonian view: Transylvania 1547. The Transylvanian order takes the opposite line on the leftovers themselves. Better to lay on too many particles than to have to consecrate again, "for one need not be anxious about what is left over". The words of consecration are to be understood with their effect, "so that only that is consecrated which is handled, as what is taken, eaten and drunk". **Transylvanian Saxons, *Kirchenordnung* (German version), 1547** (Sehling 24, p. 233):

yet where many are present together at once, that no one be cheated of his desire and the words of consecration need not through negligence be spoken anew again, it is better that one lay on more particles; one need not therefore be anxious about what is left over, for the words of consecration must be understood with their effect, so that only that is consecrated which is handled, as that which one taketh, eateth and drinketh.

13.23 Rites of the feasts and seasons

The medieval year had rites that belonged to one day only: the blessing of candles at Candlemas, the ashes of Ash Wednesday, the palms and procession of Palm Sunday, the washing of feet and of altars on Maundy Thursday, the Passion, the solemn prayers, the showing of the cross and the sepulchre on Good Friday, the new fire, paschal candle, *Exsultet* and blessing of the font on Easter Eve, the vigils of Christmas and Easter night, and the figures and dove of Ascension and Whitsun. This section sets out what the evangelical orders kept of them. The blessings themselves are treated in §13.15.1, and the image plays in Chapter 12, §12.10.10.

13.23.1 The pattern

Luther's rule. Luther would have Holy Week kept like any other week, except that the Passion is preached, without the "juggling-work" of the old ceremonies and without eight hours of Passion-preaching on Good Friday. **Luther, *Deudsche messe und ordnung gottis dienst*, 1526** (Sehling 1, p. 16):

yet not so that one keep the hunger cloth, palm-shooting, covering of images and whatever more of the juggling-work there is, or sing four Passions, or have eight hours of preaching on the Passion on Good Friday; but Holy Week shall be like other weeks, save that the Passion be preached an hour a day through the week, or as many days as one pleaseth, and that whoso will take the sacrament.

What the orders kept. Most orders follow Luther: the feast keeps its history, read and preached, its proper chant and hymns, and the Supper. A few, chiefly Electoral Brandenburg in 1540, kept much of the old ceremonial with the blessings removed

(§13.23.3–13.23.5).

What is not found. The searches found none of the following in any evangelical order:

- the *Exsultet* or Easter *praeconium*;
- the Christmas Kalenda (the proclamation of the Nativity from the martyrology);
- the imposition of ashes on Ash Wednesday;
- the putting out of the paschal candle at Ascension.

The paschal candle and new fire appear only to be abolished, and the ashes only in the lists of abolished blessings. The only Ash Wednesday custom named is a folk one: the Sponheim visitors of 1560 complain of people choosing "a mayor or king" on Ash Wednesday (Sehling 18, p. 640).

13.23.2 Christmas and the night vigils

Matins moved to the morning. Christmas and Easter Matins were kept, but not at midnight. The Palatine reform of the collegiate churches in 1546 moves them "somewhat nearer the day than at midnight". Pfalz-Neuburg 1543 sets Christmas Matins at four in the morning "to avoid all manner of danger" (Sehling 13, p. 95). **Kurpfalz, *Bedenken zur Reformation der Stiftskirchen*, 1546** (Sehling 14, p. 92):

Christmas and Easter Matins shall be held somewhat nearer the day than at midnight, in such manner as is said above of the canonical hours.

Nicolaus Hausmann's Anhalt order of 1532 says why. The night watch at Christmas and Easter would not be bad in itself, but it had brought sorcery and wantonness, and people are sleepy at midnight. **Anhalt, *Ordnung* of Nicolaus Hausmann, 1532** (Sehling 2, pp. 542–543):

It were also not evil that Christmas night and Easter were kept with the watch, as of old. But men know the great abuse and sorcery, wantonness, also fleshly lust, which have come about thereby, whence more sins came than God was served and his honour sought. The young and rough folk can be kept in the fear of God and in discipline toward the morning just as well as at midnight, and better. Every man is also sleepy and unapt for prayer.

The Brandenburg visitors of 1574 still had to tell the council to drive out "the wicked boys who do all manner of knavery in the churches on Christmas night and Easter night" (Sehling 3, p. 167).

The Christmas lessons. Where Christmas Matins survived as a morning service, it kept three lessons, the third the genealogy of Matthew 1 (*Liber generationis*). This is the nearest the orders come to the Kalenda. **Naumburg, St Wenzel, *Kirchen-Ordnung*, 1537/1538** (Sehling 2, p. 71):

and at Christmas one readeth three lessons and singeth three responsories. The first lesson is Isaiah 9, *Puer natus est nobis* (Unto us a child is born), etc.; the second the gospel of John; the third *Liber generationis*. 3. Then one maketh a sermon on the feast, as at Christmas, out of the gospel of Luke 2.

Nördlingen (in the revision of 1555) has the same three lessons, with the responsories *Hodie nobis caelorum rex* (This day for us the King of heaven), *Hodie nobis de caelo* (This day for us from heaven) and *Verbum caro factum est* (The Word was made flesh), and the *Te Deum* (We praise thee, O God) on the organ after the sermon (Sehling 12, p. 320). The Hof order of 1592 gives a full Latin Christmas Matins with invitatory, psalms, lessons and responsories (Sehling 11, pp. 412–413). The rocking of the Christ-child's cradle was abolished (Chapter 12, §12.10.10).

13.23.3 Candlemas, Ash Wednesday and Palm Sunday

Candlemas. The candles were no longer blessed (§13.15.1). What remained of the feast is its gospel and Simeon's song. Henneberg 1555 has the German *Nunc dimittis* sung "from the Sunday after Purification" (Sehling 2, p. 310), and the Mansfeld hymn list gives "Mit Fried und Freud ich fahr dahin" (With peace and joy I depart) for the day (Sehling 2, p. 235).

Ash Wednesday. No order keeps the ashes or gives a rite for the day. The day appears only as the beginning of Lent and in the lists of abolished blessings (§13.15.1).

Palm Sunday: the procession kept, the blessing dropped. Electoral Brandenburg kept the old Palm Sunday procession and chants, but not the blessing of palms. The same paragraph orders the rest of Holy Week (§§13.23.4–13.23.5). **Brandenburg (Electorate), *Kirchenordnung* of Joachim II, 1540** (Sehling 3, p. 88):

Palm Sunday shall be kept with the procession and chants as of old, yet so that the hallowing of the palms be left off; the following days with the reading of the Passions according to the text of the evangelists. But Maundy Thursday with the ceremony of the washing of feet (where it hath been in use), and in the evening after Matins let there be preaching from the Supper to the taking of Christ, etc. On Good Friday early the Passion, drawn together out of all four evangelists, shall be set forth to the people in full, and at the right time the customary office shall be performed, with the representation of the burial, as of old, yet so that therein a complete consecration and administration of the sacrament take place. Easter Eve shall be performed with the customary solemnities and ceremonies, yet with the leaving off of the hallowing of the fire [...]. So shall also Easter night be kept with the representation of the resurrection of Christ, as of old; and Easter Day with the following days shall be spent in the customary glory; likewise the Vespers with the solemnity customary at baptism; and if there be unbaptized children present at that time, they shall be baptized withal.

The *Gloria, laus*. Where there was no procession, the processional hymn *Gloria, laus et honor* (Glory, praise and honour) stayed in the service. Naumburg 1537 sings it figurally as the Palm Sunday introit (Sehling 2, p. 71), and Nördlingen likewise (Sehling 12, p. 323). At Hof in 1592 it was sung after the sermon by three choirs. **Hof, *Ordo ecclesiasticus*, 1592** (Sehling 11, p. 439):

After the sermon: *Gloria, laus et honor tibi sit*, item "Glory and honour be to thee, thou meek one", in three several choirs: so that some trebles, the cantor presiding, sing the Latin before the high altar; thereafter the whole choir, the schoolmaster governing, the German over against them; and then the little girls always the refrain, "Glory and honour be to thee".

Palm-shooting, the blessing of palms and the wooden ass were abolished everywhere else (Mülhausen 1528, Reformed, Sehling 20/2, p. 206; §13.15.1).

13.23.4 Maundy Thursday and Good Friday

Maundy Thursday. Brandenburg 1540 kept the washing of feet where it had been in use (§13.23.3). It is the only order found that does so. Elsewhere the foot-washing became a sermon: Regensburg [1567] preaches on John 13 at midday (Sehling 13, p. 477), and Wolfstein 1574 preaches on it "that the communicants be stirred to brotherly love and unity" (Sehling 13, p. 570). The day's chief rite was the Supper, with a sermon on its institution. The washing of the altars was dropped at Mülhausen in 1528 (Reformed) (Chapter 14, §14.6.6).

Good Friday: the Passion and the solemn prayers. The Good Friday service everywhere centres on the Passion read and preached. Schweinfurt keeps a Matins at five in the morning with three psalms and three lessons from the Passion, the reading of John's Passion "word for word" to the people, and the old Passion hymns. **Schweinfurt, *Kirchenordnung*, 1543** (Sehling 11, p. 636):

Of Good Friday. In the morning early at five o'clock Matins shall be sung: three antiphons, three psalms [...] three responsories. The three lessons the master or cantor shall arrange out of the history of the suffering of Christ. Then shall the chaplain stand forth and read to the people the history of the suffering of Christ described by the evangelist John, word for word. At the end of the Passion one shall sing *Vexilla regis prodeunt*, item *Crux fidelis*; collects, *Benedicamus*. On this day, if communicants be otherwise present, the Supper shall be held, since such use hath been here aforetime.

The Mülhausen preachers of 1528 (Reformed) kept the Good Friday lessons and the old solemn prayers "for the heathen, Turks, Circassians and Jews", but read them in German (Sehling 20/2, p. 207). Waldeck kept the solemn prayers as a fixed part of the day. **Waldeck, *Kirchenordnung*, 1556** (Sehling 9, p. 277):

The solemn prayers also, as they have hitherto been kept in the two churches of Korbach and Wildungen, shall be diligently performed in all churches on Good Friday before the communion.

The order prints them in full as *Precationes solennes pro singulis ordinibus et necessitatibus die Parasceues dicendae*, with German bidding prayers (§13.21.6).

Length. No order asks for a specially long service. Luther rejected eight hours of Passion-preaching (§13.23.1). Bugenhagen's Brunswick order holds half an hour of preaching on the Passion to be enough, for "the long, tedious Passion-preaching, as men were wont to do, is not profitable" (Sehling 6/1, p. 379). Württemberg 1535 kept Good Friday as a holy day "only in the

forenoon, for the Passion" (Sehling 16, p. 134). The length came instead from reading the whole Passion harmony, as at Brandenburg and Waldeck.

The cross and the sepulchre. Brandenburg kept the "representation of the burial", but with a full consecration rather than the Mass of the Presanctified. Elsewhere the showing of the crucifix and the sepulchre were dropped (§13.22.4; Chapter 14, §14.6.6). Communion on Good Friday is treated in §13.22.4.

Tenebrae. The Holy Week Matins survived at Hof as an evening office, "formerly called Tenebrae", with lessons, the responsories *In monte oliveti* and *Vinea mea electa*, a German responsory, a sermon and a Kyrie with Latin tropes (Sehling 11, pp. 415–416; Chapter 8, §8.6.4.7). Pfalz-Neuburg 1543 kept them "without all knocking, rumbling and din" (Sehling 13, p. 95).

13.23.5 Easter Eve and Easter

No new fire and no paschal candle. No evangelical order keeps the blessing of the new fire, the paschal candle or the *Exsultet*. Even Brandenburg, which kept Easter Eve "with the customary solemnities and ceremonies", left off "the hallowing of the fire" (§13.23.3). The Mülhausen preachers (Reformed) kept the consecration of the font on Easter Eve but thought the Easter candle unnecessary for it. They also dropped the fire-blessing and the daily procession to the font through Easter week. **Mülhausen, *Gutachten zu den Gottesdiensten in der Karwoche*, [1528]** (Reformed; Sehling 20/2, p. 207):

Fifthly: On the holy eve of Easter it is our mind that one consecrate the font as hitherto, yet not deem it needful to have an Easter candle thereto. Likewise the blessing of the fire may with good reason be left off. And lastly: the visiting of the font with the procession the eight days may well be put away without any error or danger; yet so far that the half Vespers which were formerly sung at the font be sung in the choir, like other Vespers.

The resurrection represented. Brandenburg 1540 kept Easter night "with the representation of the resurrection of Christ, as of old", that is, the Easter play at the sepulchre, and Easter Vespers "with the solemnity customary at baptism", baptizing any children then waiting (§13.23.3). An Easter Matins of 1544 from Bibra survives with the German *Te Deum* (We praise thee, O God), *Christ ist erstanden* (Christ is arisen) and *Verleih uns Frieden* (Grant us peace; Bibra, described by the editor, Sehling 2, p. 268). Elsewhere the Easter image plays were abolished (Chapter 12, §12.10.10). The Easter *Leise* (Leise (a vernacular hymn ending Kyrieleis)) "Christ ist erstanden" is treated in Chapter 8, §8.10.2.

13.23.6 Ascension and Whitsun

The None kept, the figures dropped. The Palatine reform of 1546 keeps the festal None of Ascension and Whitsun, but without the water poured, the hosts thrown from the vault, the fire cast down, the figure of Christ drawn up or the image of the Holy Ghost let down. **Kurpfalz, *Bedenken zur Reformation der Stiftskirchen*, 1546** (Sehling 14, p. 92):

The Nones on holy Ascension Day and Whitsun shall be sung and kept modestly and discreetly, as hitherto, excepting the pouring of water; also no hosts shall be thrown from above out of the vault, nor fire cast down; moreover no image of Christ drawn up, nor image of the Holy Ghost let down; but the singing and the sermon that followeth thereon shall be enough.

No order mentions putting out or removing the paschal candle at Ascension. Pfalz-Neuburg's editor notes the old custom of burning it until Ascension (Sehling 13, p. 96), but the order itself abolishes the candle.

Whitsun and baptism. Several orders explain that the early church baptized only at Easter and Whitsun, and that this is why the two feasts were kept (Schwäbisch Hall 1527, Sehling 17/1, p. 43; Württemberg 1553, Sehling 16, p. 232). None restores the seasons of baptism.

13.23.7 Septuagesima and Trinity Sunday

No farewell to the Alleluia. No order in the corpus has the medieval "deposition" or farewell of the Alleluia at Vespers or Compline on the eve of Septuagesima (*Alleluia, dulce carmen*, the burial of the Alleluia). Luther's *Formula missae* (Form of the Mass) states the opposite principle: Lent, Holy Week and Good Friday are not to be paraded with other rites than the rest of the year, "for the Alleluia is the perpetual voice of the church". **Luther, *Formula missae et communionis*, 1523** (Sehling 1, p. 5):

But neither is it fitting to show off Lent itself, or the Great Week, or the sixth day [Good Friday] as penitential with other rites than any other [days], lest we seem to wish further to mock and deride Christ with a half-Mass and with one part of the sacrament. For the Alleluia is the perpetual voice of the church, as the memorial of his passion and victory is perpetual.

The Hildesheim order of 1544 repeats the phrase when it orders the children to sing the Alleluia with its verse, though without the long melisma. **Hildesheim, *Christlike kerckenordeninge*, 1544** (Sehling 7/2.1, p. 853):

The Alleluia, which is an everlasting voice of the church, the children sing with the verse, yet leaving out the many notes which men were wont to hang on at the end.

The season still marked. Other orders kept the old seasonal exchange without any rite of farewell. Electoral Brandenburg sings after the epistle "the Alleluia and the sequence, if one be kept, or according to the season a tract in Latin" (Sehling 3, p. 68). The Palatinate in 1546 and the Transylvanian order of 1547 likewise put a tract such as *Domine, non secundum* (O Lord, deal not with us) in Lent (Sehling 14, p. 96; 24, p. 223). At Hof in 1592 Septuagesima is marked by the Lenten Kyrie at Mass and the plain *Benedicamus dominicale* "from Septuagesima until the feast of Easter". The Septuagesima Vespers hymn *Dies absoluti praetereunt* is noted as "formerly sung" (Sehling 11, pp. 414, 436).

The Athanasian Creed on Trinity Sunday. Several orders make the Athanasian Creed the text of Trinity Sunday:

- **Regensburg [1567]** reads it at Trinity Vespers, after Isaiah 6 at the vigil and Genesis 18 and Matthew 3 in the morning.
- **Thüngen 1587** reads it at the vigil and on the feast (Sehling 11, p. 744).
- **Albrechtshain 1554** takes it as the text of the afternoon catechism sermon on Trinity (Sehling 1, p. 519).
- **Pomerania 1569** has it preached in German on Trinity afternoon in town and village. The Pomeranian hymn list and the Kolberg convent statutes of 1586 set it, in German, among the Trinity songs (Sehling 4, pp. 478, 502).
- **The Mecklenburg convents** sing it in German after the *Benedictus* on all the high feasts, Trinity among them (Chapter 12, §12.10.8).

Regensburg, *Kirchenordnung*, [1567] (Sehling 13, p. 478):

Trinity. On the eve at Vespers is read the vision of Isaiah, chapter 6. In the morning, in place of the epistle, the vision of Abraham, Genesis 18; in place of the gospel, the revelation of the Trinity in the baptism of Christ, Matthew 3. At Vespers the Athanasian Creed.

Pomerania, *Agenda*, 1569 (Sehling 4, p. 477):

Preaching on the feast day of Trinity. On the day of the Holy Trinity one shall preach in the afternoon, in towns and in villages, the German Athanasian Creed, which followeth hereafter; [shall] instruct the congregation diligently of the persons of the Godhead, not study after higher art, [and] exhort all Christians to gather in numbers to such preaching.

The Pomeranian order of 1542 had already prescribed the *Quicunque vult* (Whosoever will) once a week before the sermon, with an antiphon *de Trinitate* (of the Trinity; Sehling 4, p. 357). Its use at Sunday Prime and in the schools is treated in Chapter 10, and in the Mass after the gospel in Chapter 8.

13.24 Table by order

How to read the table. The table lists the orders that give the principal forms. For each order it shows which rites it supplies in full or in quotation, and what it abolishes. Section numbers refer to this chapter.

Order	Forms given (§)	Abolished, rejected or omitted (§)
Luther, *Taufbüchlein* 1523 and 1526	baptism with the received ceremonies (13.3.2); revised baptism (13.3.3)	salt, spittle, oil, chrism, candle in 1526 (13.3.3)
Luther, *Traubüchlein* 1529	betrothal and marriage at the church door and before the altar (13.7.1)	the nuptial Mass
Luther, ordination form 1539	ordination with laying on of hands (13.10.2)	episcopal consecration
Saxony (Ernestine), *Unterricht der Visitatoren* 1528	weather-ringing kept as a call to prayer (13.15.5)	the trust in blessed bells

Order	Forms given (§)	Abolished, rejected or omitted (§)
Saxony (Albertine), *Kirchenordnung* 1539	baptism with exhortation (13.3.4); emergency baptism (13.3.7); communion of the sick (13.8.3); funerals (13.9.2)	extreme unction (13.8.1)
Saxony (Albertine), *Gemeiner Bericht* 1540	—	churching of women and brides, sprinkling, salt and water, weather-ringing (13.5.1)
Electoral Saxony, Wittenberg consistory 1542	communion of the sick (13.8.2); form of excommunication and reconciliation (13.16.2)	reserved sacrament (13.8.2)
Electoral Saxony, *Wittenbergische Reformation* 1545	confirmation (13.6.1); ordination (13.10.1)	—
Saxony, *Ordnung* of Duke August 1580	godparents (13.3.8); confirmation (13.6.7); investiture of pastors (13.11.1); *Kirmes* (parish fair) dancing limited (13.14.4)	weather-ringing and bell baptism (13.15.5)
Electoral Brandenburg 1540	baptism with oil of catechumens, chrism, white cap and candle (13.3.2, 13.15.4); private confession and absolution with laying on of hands (13.17.3); Sunday, Palm Sunday and Rogation processions (13.18.2); confirmation (13.6.4); Sunday procession without water (13.15.2)	blessings of water, salt, herbs, candles (13.15.2)
Brandenburg-Nürnberg 1533	baptism with exhortations (13.3.1, 13.3.4); marriage (13.7.2); funerals (13.9.3)	churching (13.5.1); oil and salt at baptism (13.3.2); font blessing 1528 (13.15.3); the yearly blessings (13.15.1)
Nuremberg, Dietrich's *Agendbüchlein* 1545	exorcism glossed as prayer (13.4.1); the dying (13.8.4); the condemned (13.8.6); funerals (13.9.1)	—
Brandenburg-Ansbach-Kulmbach	marriage, Hof 1592 (13.7.4); dedication of 1572, its yearly festival and the school dedication of 1546, Hof 1592 (13.14.3)	exorcism mitigated 1591–1594 (13.4.3)
Württemberg 1536 and 1553	baptism (13.3.5); visitation of the sick (13.8.2); marriage and the wreath (13.7.6); investiture of prelates (13.11.3)	exorcism (13.3.5)
Strasbourg 1525 and 1537 (Moderate Reformed)	baptism (13.3.5); marriage with the impediments asked thrice (13.7.3)	exorcism (13.3.5); oil and chrism, 1525 (13.15.4)
Hesse (Moderate Reformed to 1566; Philippist, 1574)	confirmation, Ziegenhain 1539 (13.6.2); ordination of elders and deacons 1566 (13.12.1); deposition of ministers 1566 (13.19.3); ordination, Agende 1574 (13.10.5)	dedications, Homberg 1526 (13.14.1)
Calenberg-Göttingen 1542	confirmation (13.6.3)	blessings of salt, water, herbs, palms, *Fladen* (flat cakes; 13.15.1)
Mansfeld 1554 and 1580	godparents (13.3.8); churching as thanksgiving (13.5.2); confirmation (13.6.5); funerals (13.9.4); ban, open penance and absolution (13.16.5)	—
Pomerania 1569	exorcism (13.4.1); prayer over the possessed (13.8.7)	—
Regensburg	ordination 1553? (13.10.4); funerals 1560 (13.9.4); plague order 1562 (13.8.5); dedication anniversary about 1567 (13.14.3)	—

Order	Forms given (§)	Abolished, rejected or omitted (§)
Merseburg 1545	ordination within the Mass (13.10.3)	—
Schleswig-Holstein 1542	ordination of bishops (13.11.4)	—
Kurpfalz (Lutheran 1556, 1577 and 1580; Reformed 1563, 1572 and 1592)	Luther's catechism form of confession, 1556 (13.17.2); Reformed baptism (13.3.6); annulment, 1563 (13.7.10); ordination (13.10.5); presentation of ministers (13.11.2); installation of elders 1592 (13.12.1); stewards' oath 1577 (13.12.4); schoolmaster's promise 1580, Heidelberg bell-ringer 1572 (12.2–12.3); exclusion by elders (13.16.8)	emergency baptism by women; exorcism (13.3.6)
Saxe-Lauenburg 1585	churchwarden's oath (13.12.4); lesser and greater ban; public penance and absolution (13.16.1, 13.16.3)	—
Mecklenburg 1570	consistory process, form of excommunication, absolution from the ban (13.16.4)	—
Wertheim 1530/1555	the pastor's examination at the betrothal (13.7.8)	secret betrothals
Saxony (Albertine), *Dresdener Ehe-Ordnung* 1556	divorce for adultery (13.7.10)	—
Electoral Brandenburg 1573	remarriage of the innocent divorced party (13.7.10)	—
Pfalz-Zweibrücken 1539	visitation of the sick by James 5 (13.8.1)	the oil of the sick (13.8.1)
Lippe 1538	the gospel in place of the last oil (13.8.1)	extreme unction (13.8.1)
Esslingen 1532 (Moderate Reformed)	—	the tonsure (13.19.1)
Salza 1540	—	altars, images, a chapel (13.19.2)
Grubenhagen 1581	lesser and greater ban (13.16.1); absolution from the ban (13.16.6)	—
Micron's *Ordinancien* 1554 (East Frisia 1565) (Reformed)	installation of elders and deacons (13.12.1); Reformed excommunication and readmission (13.16.7)	—
Lippe 1571	the sexton's pledge (13.12.2)	charms and amulets (13.12.2)
Leisnig 1529	election of churchwardens (13.12.4)	—
Lüneburg 1564	appointment of midwives (13.12.5)	—
Mulhouse 1551 (Reformed)	the schoolmaster's oath (13.12.3)	—
Gengenbach 1536 (Moderate Reformed)	the schoolmaster's appointment (13.12.3)	—
Hildesheim 1581	the organist's contract (13.12.3)	—
Strasbourg 1523 (Moderate Reformed)	the oath of the steward of the poor (13.12.4)	—
Strasbourg 1531 (Moderate Reformed)	appointment of *Sigristen* (13.12.2)	—
Sayn 1590	surety for the bell-ringer who keeps the vessels (13.12.2)	—

Order	Forms given (§)	Abolished, rejected or omitted (§)
Anhalt 1594 (Philippist)	the sexton's yearly appointment (13.12.2)	—
Nördlingen 1544	examination of the sick-women by the pastor (13.12.6)	—
Heilbronn 1531	the beguines' troth and instruction (13.12.6)	—
Nassau-Dillenburg, Keppel 1570	clothing of a nun with questions, oath, sermon and exhortation (13.12.7); election, oath and presentation of the *domina* (13.12.8)	binding vows; the convent as a prison (13.12.7)
Lüneburg 1574	clothing under the duke's command (13.12.7); burial in a linen sheet (13.12.10)	cowl, veil and crown (13.12.7, 13.12.10)
Strasbourg 1555	admission by the council (13.12.7); promise of the mother and council-mothers (13.12.8)	—
Schleswig-Holstein after 1610	election of abbess and prioress under oath; the sisters' oath of obedience (13.12.8)	—
Württemberg 1535 and 1552	—	admission of monks, nuns, beguines and Lollards; novices' vows (13.12.7, 13.12.9)
Goslar, Frankenberg 1542	—	admission to the habit (13.12.7, 13.12.9)
Esslingen 1535 (Moderate Reformed)	settlement or maintenance of the friars (13.12.9)	—
Pfalz-Simmern, Ravengiersburg 1560	reception of novices as scholars; the stipendiary's obligation (13.12.9)	—
Brunswick-Wolfenbüttel 1569	words for laying aside the habit (13.12.10)	—
Schwäbisch Hall 1543/1615	council-election sermon (13.13.1)	consecration of churchyards (13.14.1)
Pfalz-Neuburg 1543 and 1560	baptism with oil and chrism (13.3.2); visitation service (13.22.1)	the yearly blessings (13.15.1); weather-ringing (13.15.5)
Waldeck 1583 and 1584	—	*Kirchweih* (church dedication festival; 13.14.4); exorcism and the baptismal robe (13.4.4)
Halberstadt 1588	—	church dedication and font blessing (13.14.1)
Thüngen 1564	—	churching (13.5.1); weather-ringing (13.15.5)
Stendal 1541	order of the Rogation procession: cross, schoolboys, priests, people (13.18.4)	—
Waldeck 1556	funeral procession: sexton with cross, schoolboys, schoolmaster, pastor (13.18.4)	—

Order	Forms given (§)	Abolished, rejected or omitted (§)
Havelberg 1558	the Sunday circuit with council and congregation following (13.18.4)	—
Perleberg 1581	surplices for pastor, chaplains and sexton at funerals (13.18.4)	—
Baden 1533	the sacrament carried to the sick with light and bells (13.18.4)	—
Kronstadt 1543	communion of the sick (13.18.4)	candles, bells and pomp (13.18.4)
Mecklenburg 1552	—	banners and processional crosses (13.18.4)
Strasbourg 1598	the council procession to the Minster (13.18.4)	—
Brandenburg-Ansbach-Kulmbach, *Landtagsabschied* 1526	leftovers kept in the sacrament house for the sick and later communicants (13.22.3)	—
Nuremberg *Lehrartikel* and Brandenburg-Nürnberg 1528	—	locking up and carrying about the sacrament (13.22.3)
Brunswick 1528, Hamburg 1529, Rostock about 1560	communion on Good Friday as on a Sunday (13.22.4)	Mass of the Presanctified (13.22.4)
Goslar (Nuremberg report) 1528, Mülhausen 1528 (Reformed), Feuchtwangen 1563, Teschen 1584	—	Easter sepulchre (13.22.4); ciborium (Teschen, 20.3)
Merseburg 1544, Pfalz-Neuburg 1543, Hohenlohe 1553, Wolfstein 1574, Lüneburg 1575	remaining elements consumed by minister or communicants (13.22.5)	reservation (13.22.3, 13.22.5)
Transylvanian Saxons 1547	—	communion from hosts kept "in corners" (13.22.3); anxiety over leftovers (13.22.5)
Electoral Brandenburg 1540 (Holy Week)	Palm Sunday procession, Maundy Thursday foot-washing, Good Friday burial and Easter resurrection represented, Easter Vespers with baptism (13.23.3)	blessing of palms and of the fire (13.23.3)
Kurpfalz *Bedenken* 1546, Pfalz-Neuburg 1543, Anhalt 1532	Christmas and Easter Matins toward morning; Ascension and Whitsun None (13.23.2, 13.23.6)	midnight watch; water, hosts, fire, figures and dove at Ascension and Whitsun (13.23.6)
Naumburg 1537, Nördlingen 1555, Hof 1592	Christmas Matins lessons with *Liber generationis*; *Gloria, laus* on Palm Sunday; Tenebrae as an evening office (21.2–21.4)	—
Schweinfurt 1543, Mülhausen 1528 (Reformed), Waldeck 1556	Good Friday Matins and Passion; solemn prayers in German (13.23.4)	Easter candle, fire-blessing, font procession (Mülhausen, 21.5)
Luther *Formula missae* 1523, Hildesheim 1544	Alleluia as "the perpetual voice of the church" (13.23.7)	penitential rites peculiar to Lent and Holy Week

Order	Forms given (§)	Abolished, rejected or omitted (§)
		(13.23.7)
Regensburg [1567], Thüngen 1587, Albrechtshain 1554, Pomerania 1569, Kolberg 1586	Athanasian Creed read, sung or preached on Trinity Sunday (13.23.7)	—
Niemegk 1529, Pfalz-Neuburg 1543, Grubenhagen 1544, Mecklenburg 1552, Lüneburg 1564	Litany in place of the Supper when no one communes (13.21.1)	—
Transylvanian Saxons 1547	Creed with suffrages for the king, for sins and for peace in the service without communion (13.21.1)	—
Hof 1592	weekday *Tagmeß* (day Mass) with the Litany divided over four days (13.21.1)	Litany left out at a baptism (13.21.1)
Dietrich 1545, Amberg 1550, Waldeck 1556, Mecklenburg 1542	Litany after the epistle, during communion, after the sermon (13.21.2)	—
Calenberg 1542, Heidelberg chapter 1546, Pomerania 1569	Rogation Litany without the saints (13.21.4)	the procession; *Sancte Petre, ora pro nobis* (Saint Peter, pray for us; 13.21.4)
Zweibrücken 1533, Pfalz-Veldenz 1574	Litany in the Christmas, Easter and Whitsun weeks (13.21.5)	—
Schwäbisch Hall 1543, Limpurg 1610	Litany on Good Friday (13.21.6)	—
Waldeck 1556	eleven Good Friday biddings with collects, in German (13.21.6)	*Flectamus genua*; the prayers for the pope and the pagans (13.21.6)
Braunschweig 1528, Transylvanian Saxons 1547, Leiningen 1566, Wolfstein 1574	—	holy water, exorcized salt and hallowed herbs and candles against the devil and as means of sorcery (13.20.1)
Mecklenburg 1540/1545, Pomerania 1542	blessing of the house of the sick against the devil's spooks (13.20.2)	—
Württemberg 1552, Hohenlohe 1558 and 1588, Castell 1579	public burning of charms, written blessings, hallowed and bewitched things and sorcerers' books (13.20.3)	—
Mecklenburg 1552, Sponheim 1566 (the Palatine councillors), Transylvanian Saxons 1607	worshipped images broken and burned; fonts and sacrament-houses broken down (13.20.4)	—
Wolfstein 1574, Upper Palatinate 1579, Grubenhagen 1581	baptismal water poured away at once; nothing laid under the altar cloth (13.20.5)	the gift or sale of the baptismal water (13.20.5)

Order	Forms given (§)	Abolished, rejected or omitted (§)
Nassau-Dillenburg 1570 and 1582 (Reformed), Transylvanian Saxons 1595	public apology and absolution; exclusion from the Supper; inquiry before arrest (13.20.6)	—

13.25 Concordance of the orders quoted

The concordance. Every order quoted in this chapter is listed below, with the volume and pages of Sehling and the sections where it is quoted. Orders cited only in summary can be found through the table in §13.24 and the text.

Order	Title	Date	Sehling	Quoted in §
Amberg	*Kirchenordnung*	1550	13, p. 286	13.21.2
Anhalt	*Ordnung* of Nicolaus Hausmann	1532	2, pp. 542–543	13.23.2
Baden	*Kirchenordnung*	1533	16, p. 510	13.18.4
Bentheim-Tecklenburg (Reformed)	*Kirchenordnung*	1588	22, p. 269	13.4.4
Brandenburg (Electorate)	*Kirchenordnung*	of Joachim II, 1540	3, pp. 54, 58–59, 59, 62–63, 81, 88	13.3.2, 13.6.4, 13.15.2, 13.17.3, 13.18.2, 13.18.4, 13.23.3
Brandenburg (Electorate)	*Visitation- und Consistorialordnung*	1573	3, p. 128	13.7.10
Brandenburg-Ansbach-Kulmbach	*Landtagsabschied*	1526	11, p. 91	13.22.3
Brandenburg-Ansbach-Kulmbach	*Ordo ecclesiasticus*	1592	11, p. 456	13.7.4
Brandenburg-Ansbach-Kulmbach	*Konsistorialordnung*	1594	11, p. 392	13.4.3
Brandenburg-Nürnberg	*Kirchenordnung*	1528	11, pp. 135, 138	13.3.2, 13.22.3
Brandenburg-Nürnberg	*Kirchenordnung*	1533	11, pp. 174, 177, 180, 201–202, 203	13.3.1, 13.3.4, 13.5.1, 13.7.2, 13.9.3
Braunschweig	*Kirchenordnung*	1528	6/1, pp. 360, 389–390, 391, 428	13.4.2, 13.20.1, 13.20.2
Brunswick	*Kirchenordnung*	1528	6/1, p. 379	13.22.4
Brunswick-Wolfenbüttel	*Klosterordnung*	1569	6/1, pp. 325–326	13.12.10

Order	Title	Date	Sehling	Quoted in §
Calenberg-Göttingen	*Ordnung der confirmation oder firmung*	1542	6/2, pp. 838–839, 843	13.6.3
Calenberg-Göttingen	*Kirchenordnung*	1542	6/2, pp. 799, 812	13.15.1, 13.21.4
Castell	*Dorfordnung für Obereisenheim*	1579	11, p. 691	13.20.3
Electoral Saxony	*Constitution und artikel des geistlichen consistorii zu Wittemberg*	1542	1, pp. 202, 206	13.8.2, 13.16.2
Electoral Saxony	*Wittenbergische Reformation*	1545	1, p. 211	13.6.1, 13.10.1
Esslingen (Moderate Reformed)	*Mandat für die altgläubigen Geistlichen*	10 August 1532	17/2, p. 371	13.19.1
Gengenbach (Moderate Reformed)	*Bestallung eines Schulmeysters der Statt Gengenbach*	1536	17/1, p. 483	13.12.3
Goslar	*Bericht der Stadt Nürnberg für den Goslarer Rat*	30 March 1528	7/2.2, p. 232	13.22.4
Grubenhagen	*Kirchenordnung*	1544	6/2, p. 1033	13.21.1
Grubenhagen	*Kirchenordnung*	1581	6/2, pp. 1049, 1052, 1058	13.16.1, 13.16.6, 13.20.5
Halberstadt	*Instruktion für die Visitation*	8 August 1588	2, p. 470	13.14.1
Havelberg	*Abschied*	1558	3, p. 232	13.18.4
Heidelberg (Reformed)	*Bestallung eines Glöckners*	15 May 1572	14, p. 457	13.12.2
Heilbronn	*Instruktion zur Zusammenlegung beider Beginenhäuser*	8 December 1531	17/1, p. 298	13.12.6
Henneberg	*Kirchenordnung*	of Georg Ernst, 1582	2, pp. 304–305	13.4.3
Herford	*Kirchenordnung*	1532	21, p. 192	13.7.4
Hesse (Moderate Reformed)	*Reformatio ecclesiarum Hassiae*	(Homberg), 1526	8, p. 50	13.14.1
Hesse (Moderate Reformed)	*Ziegenhainer Zuchtordnung*	1539	8, p. 104	13.6.2
Hesse (Moderate Reformed)	*Kirchenordnung*	1566	8, pp. 209, 211, 211–212	13.12.1, 13.19.3
Hesse (Philippist)	*Agende*	1574	8, pp. 454–455	13.10.5
Hildesheim	*Christlike kerckenordeninge*	1544	7/2.1, p. 853	13.23.7
Hildesheim	*Bestallung des Organisten Severus Kroschen*	1581	7/2.1, p. 901	13.12.3
Hof	*Ordo ecclesiasticus*	1592	11, pp. 439, 455, 463, 464, 467	13.14.3, 13.18.4, 13.21.1, 13.23.3

Order	Title	Date	Sehling	Quoted in §
Hohenlohe	*Kirchenordnung*	1553	15, p. 72	13.22.5
Hohenlohe	*Polizeiordnung*	1558	15, p. 139	13.20.3
Kronstadt	*Reformationsbüchlein*	German version, 1543	24, p. 196	13.18.4
Kurpfalz	*Bedenken zur Reformation der Stiftskirchen*	1546	14, p. 92	13.23.2, 13.23.6
Kurpfalz (Reformed)	*Kirchenordnung*	1563	14, pp. 337, 340	13.3.6
Kurpfalz (Reformed)	*Ordnung der Ordination*	1592	19/2, p. 792	13.10.5
Kurpfalz (Reformed)	*Ordnung der Einführung der Kirchendiener*	1592	19/2, p. 793	13.11.2
Kurpfalz (Reformed)	*Einführung der Senioren*	9 December 1592	19/2, pp. 789–790	13.12.1
Leiningen	*Kirchenzuchtordnung*	1566	19/1, p. 228	13.20.1
Leisnig	*Verordnung der Visitatoren für das Amt Leisnig*	1529	1, p. 609	13.12.4
Lippe	*Kirchenordnung*	1538	21, p. 319	13.8.1
Lippe	*Kirchenordnung*	1571	21, p. 447	13.12.2
Luther	*Das taufbuchlin verdeutscht*	1523, epilogue	1, p. 20	13.3.1
Luther	*Das taufbuchlin verdeutscht*	1523	1, pp. 19–20	13.3.2
Luther	*Formula missae et communionis*	1523	1, p. 5	13.23.7
Luther	*Das taufbuchlin verdeudscht aufs neu zu gericht*	1526	1, pp. 22–23	13.3.3
Luther	*Deudsche messe und ordnung gottis diensts*	1526	1, p. 16	13.23.1
Luther	*Traubüchlein*	1529	1, p. 24	13.7.1
Luther	*Forma ordinationis latina*	1539	1, p. 28	13.10.2
Lüneburg	*Kirchenordnung*	1564	6/1, pp. 557–558	13.12.5
Lüneburg	*Kirchenordnung*	1575	6/1, pp. 655, 660	13.21.2, 13.22.5
Mansfeld	*Form und weise einer visitation*	1554	2, p. 192	13.3.8
Mansfeld	*Kirchen-Agenda*	1580	2, pp. 222, 223, 234, 241–242, 242–243, 246	13.5.2, 13.6.5, 13.9.4, 13.16.5
Marggrabowa	*Gottesdienstordnung*	1581	4, p. 149	13.21.3
Mecklenburg	*Ordeninge der misse*	1540/1545	5, p. 158	13.20.2
Mecklenburg	*Verordnung der Visitatoren*	1542	5, p. 149	13.21.2
Mecklenburg	*Visitations-Instruction*	12 November 1552	5, p. 220	13.18.4

Order	Title	Date	Sehling	Quoted in §
Mecklenburg	*Processus visitationis*	1552	5, p. 224	13.20.4
Mecklenburg	*Kirchenordnung*	1552	5, p. 202	13.21.1
Mecklenburg	*Consistorialordnung*	1570	5, pp. 245–246, 246	13.16.4
Merseburg	*Synodalunterricht*	1544	2, p. 18	13.22.5
Merseburg	*Ordinations-Ordnung (Georg of Anhalt's draft, editor's summary)*	1545	2, p. 7	13.10.3
Micron (Reformed)	*Ordinancien*	(1554), East Frisian German edition, 1565	7/1, pp. 596, 597–598, 652	13.12.1, 13.16.7
Mulhouse (Reformed)	*Eid des Schulmeisters*	1551	20/2, p. 251	13.12.3
Mülhausen (Reformed)	*Gutachten zu den Gottesdiensten in der Karwoche*	[1528]	20/2, p. 207	13.23.5
Nassau-Dillenburg	*Kirchenordnung*	1537	10, p. 76	13.15.1
Nassau-Dillenburg	*Ordnung für das Kloster Keppel*	1570	10, pp. 138, 139, 141	13.12.7
Nassau-Dillenburg	*Ordnung für das Kloster Keppel*	1570, "The domina's oath"	10, pp. 141–142	13.12.8
Nassau-Dillenburg	*Visitationsabschied*	1570	10, p. 113	13.20.6
Nassau-Dillenburg (Philippist)	*Agende*	1575	10, p. 150	13.4.4
Nassau-Dillenburg (Reformed)	*Zaubereimandat*	1582	10, p. 175	13.20.6
Naumburg	*Kirchen-Ordnung für die St. Wenzelskirche*	1537/1538	2, p. 71	13.23.2
Nuremberg	*Die Nürnberger 23 Lehrartikel*	1528	11, p. 134	13.22.3
Nuremberg	*Agendbüchlein*	of Veit Dietrich, 1545	11, pp. 498, 506, 522, 528, 531–532	13.4.1, 13.8.4, 13.8.6, 13.9.1, 13.21.2, 13.22.5
Nördlingen	*Kirchenordnung Kaspar Löners*	1544	12, p. 315	13.12.6
Palatinate	*Kirchenordnung*	of Ottheinrich, 1556	14, p. 140	13.17.2
Palatinate (Reformed)	*Ehegerichtsordnung*	1563	14, p. 327	13.7.10
Palatinate (Reformed)	*Eid der Kirchenschaffner*	May 1577	19/2, p. 749	13.12.4
Palatinate	*Verzeichnuß etlicher capitum, darauf ein jeder schulmeister … promission thun solle*	1580	14, pp. 508–509	13.12.3
Perleberg	*Visitations-Abschied*	1581	3, p. 256	13.18.4

Order	Title	Date	Sehling	Quoted in §
Pfalz-Neuburg	*Kirchenordnung*	1543	13, pp. 55, 76, 77, 96–97	13.3.2, 13.15.1, 13.18.1, 13.21.1, 13.22.5
Pfalz-Neuburg	*Visitationsordnung*	1560/1566	13, p. 140	13.22.1
Pfalz-Simmern	*Klosterordnung Ravengiersburg*	1560	19/2, p. 658	13.12.9
Pfalz-Veldenz	*Kirchenordnung*	1574	18, p. 519	13.21.5
Pfalz-Zweibrücken	*12 Artikel "Form und Maß"*	1533	18, p. 52	13.21.5
Pfalz-Zweibrücken	*Form und Ordnung*	1539	18, pp. 59, 61	13.4.1, 13.8.1
Pomerania	*Kerckenordeninge*	1569	4, p. 386	13.4.1
Pomerania	*Agenda*	1569	4, pp. 461–462, 466, 477	13.8.7, 13.21.4, 13.23.7
Pomesania	*Themata episcopi Risenburgensis*	1524	4, p. 29	13.15.1
Prussia	*Visitationsabschied für Zinten*	1575	4, p. 153	13.7.9
Regensburg	*Form der Ordination oder Priesterweihe*	1553?	13, pp. 429, 430–431	13.10.4
Regensburg	*Erklärung … welchen … leichpredig und leichgesänge nit mögen zugelassen werden*	1560	13, p. 448	13.9.4
Regensburg	*Ordnung für die Geistlichen zur Pestzeit*	1562	13, p. 435	13.8.5
Regensburg	*Kirchenordnung*	[1567]	13, p. 478	13.23.7
Rostock	*Conformitas ceremoniarum*	about 1560	5, p. 290	13.22.4
Salza	*Kirchen-Ordnung für Salza*	1540	1, p. 654	13.19.2
Saxe-Lauenburg	*Kirchenordnung*	1585	5, pp. 420, 448, 449, 453	13.12.4, 13.16.1, 13.16.3
Saxony	*Ordnung*	of Duke August, 1580	1, pp. 383, 425, 426, 427, 453	13.3.8, 13.6.7, 13.11.1, 13.15.5, 13.17.1
Saxony (Albertine)	*Kirchenordnung*	1539	1, pp. 266, 267–268, 270–271, 275	13.3.4, 13.3.7, 13.8.3, 13.9.2
Saxony (Albertine)	*Gemeiner Bericht der Visitatorn*	1540	1, p. 285	13.5.1
Saxony (Albertine)	*Dresdener Ehe-Ordnung*	1556	1, p. 343	13.7.10
Saxony (Ernestine)	*Unterricht der Visitatoren*	1528	1, pp. 170–171	13.15.5
Schleswig-Holstein	*Kirchenordnung*	1542	23, p. 120	13.11.4
Schleswig-Holstein	*Klosterordnung für Frauenklöster*	after 1610	23, p. 182	13.12.8
Schweinfurt	*Kirchenordnung*	1543	11, p. 636	13.23.4
Schwäbisch Hall	*Kirchenordnung*	1543/1615	17/1, pp. 165, 166, 175	13.13.1, 13.14.1, 13.21.6

Order	Title	Date	Sehling	Quoted in §
Sponheim (Vordere Grafschaft)	*Reformation in der Vorderen Grafschaft Sponheim*	1566	18, p. 630	13.20.4
Stendal	*Ordinance of the visitors of the Mark Brandenburg*	1541	3, p. 314	13.18.4
Stift Verden	*Kirchenordnung*	1606	7/1, p. 172	13.4.1
Strasbourg (Moderate Reformed)	*German baptism (early agendas)*	1524	20/1, p. 124	13.3.2
Strasbourg (Moderate Reformed)	*Agende*	1537	20/1, pp. 263–264, 269	13.3.5, 13.7.3
Strasbourg	*Kirchenordnung*	1598	20/1, p. 592	13.18.4
Strasbourg (Moderate Reformed)	*Armenordnung*	longer version, 4 August 1523	20/1, p. 113	13.12.4
Teschen	*Kirchenordnung*	1584	3, p. 461	13.22.3
Thüngen	*Kirchenordnung*	1564	11, p. 740	13.5.1
Transylvanian Saxons	*Kirchenordnung* (German version)	1547	24, pp. 233, 235	13.22.3, 13.22.5
Transylvanian Saxons	*Kirchenordnung* (Latin version)	1547	24, pp. 223, 225	13.20.1, 13.21.1
Transylvanian Saxons	*Synodalartikel gegen Zauberei* (Mediasch)	1595	24, p. 478	13.20.6
Transylvanian Saxons	*Articuli de ceremoniis*	1607	24, p. 493	13.20.4
Upper Palatinate	*Visitationsordnung*	1579	13, p. 317	13.20.5
Waldeck	*Kirchenordnung*	1556	9, pp. 256, 277, 278, 280	13.18.4, 13.21.2, 13.21.6, 13.23.4
Waldeck	*Mandat zur Abschaffung von Taufexorzismus und Taufkleid*	21 August 1584	9, p. 300	13.4.4
Waldeck	*Mandat zur Abschaffung der Kirchweihfeste*	8 August 1583	9, p. 299	13.14.4
Wertheim	*Kirchenordnung*	about 1555, incorporating the instruction of 1530	11, p. 717	13.7.8
Wolfstein	*Christliche Instructio des Thomas Stieber*	1574	13, pp. 572, 575, 578	13.20.1, 13.20.5, 13.22.5
Württemberg	*Kirchenordnung*	1536	16, pp. 111, 113	13.3.5, 13.8.2
Württemberg	*Kirchenordnung*	1553	16, pp. 232–233	13.3.5
Württemberg	*Eheordnung*	1553	16, p. 279	13.7.6

Order	Title	Date	Sehling	Quoted in §
Württemberg	*Investiturordnung für evangelische Prälaten*	after 1556	16, pp. 321–322	13.11.3
Ysenburg-Birstein	*Kirchenordnung*	1588	10, p. 628	13.4.3

Chapter 14. Art, Architecture, Paraments and Vestments

This chapter covers the visible furnishing of worship in the church orders of the sixteenth century printed in Emil Sehling's *Die evangelischen Kirchenordnungen des XVI. Jahrhunderts* (The Evangelical Church Orders of the Sixteenth Century). It asks:

- **Art.** Which images did the orders keep, and which did they remove? How were they to be removed? What became of the crucifix, the altar panels, carved and painted figures, banners and processional crosses? Were new pictures ever ordered?
- **Architecture and furnishings.** How many altars were kept, and where did the minister stand at them? Were altars replaced by tables? What became of the lights on the altar, the sacrament house, the font, the choir screen? What do the orders say of the pulpit, pews, galleries and windows?
- **Paraments.** What cloths covered the altar, pulpit and font? What became of the corporal and pall, the cloth held under the communicants, the chalices and the stock of old vestments?
- **Seasons and colours.** Did vestments or paraments change colour with the church year? Were there more or fewer candles on feasts or in certain seasons? What became of the Lenten veil, the Easter sepulchre and paschal candle, Candlemas candles, and seasonal greenery?
- **Vestments.** Was the Mass vestment (chasuble) kept, and with or without alb? When was the cope worn, and when only the surplice? Which orders abolished all three? What were ministers to wear outside the service?

How the chapter is laid out.

- §14.1 answers each question in brief, and §14.2 sets out the scope, the search terms and the negative findings.
- §14.3 sets out the principle under which every one of these things was handled: they are *adiaphora*, things indifferent, kept or dropped for order, for the weak, or against superstition.
- §14.4 covers images and crucifixes: the Lutheran distinction between idols and histories, orderly removal, new pictures, the Reformed clearances, the crucifix, and banners and processional crosses.
- §14.5 covers the building and its furnishings: altars, the minister's position, tables in place of altars, lights, the sacrament house, the font, and the pulpit, screens, pews, galleries and windows.
- §14.6 covers paraments, linens and vessels, colours and the seasons, and the paten, host box and bread dish.
- §14.7 covers vestments: the Mass vestment kept, the cope, the vestments abolished, and the surplice.
- §14.8 covers clerical dress outside the service.
- §14.9 is a table by order, and §14.10 a concordance of every order quoted.

Related chapters. Several passages are treated more fully elsewhere and are only cited here:

- vesting prayers before Mass: Chapter 3, §3.6.1;
- vestments and the elevation at Anhalt, and the image plays of the feasts abolished: Chapter 12, §§12.10.6, 12.10.10;
- the dedication of churches, the blessing of the font, surplices in funeral processions, and churches, altars and vessels returned to common use: Chapter 13, §§13.14, 13.15.3, 13.18, 13.19.2;
- the tonsure and the minister's dress as human ordinances, the thurifer and candle-bearer, and the deacons' and sextons' care of altar, pulpit and font: Chapter 16, §§16.3.3, 16.4.4, 16.7.2;
- bells and the organ: Chapter 9;
- the sign of the cross, kneeling and places at the altar in the Mass: Chapter 2, §2.15;
- the conduct and dress required of ministers' households: Chapter 15, §15.3.3.

14.1 Summary of findings

1. Everything is "indifferent", and that decides everything (§14.3). Vestments, cloths, vessels, lights, images and altars are *adiaphora*: they "give and take nothing to faith and conscience" (Brandenburg-Nürnberg 1533). The orders reach three different conclusions from that one principle:

- *Keep them* for good order, for uniformity with Wittenberg and the neighbouring churches, and for the weak: Hannover 1536, Thüngen 1564, Hildesheim 1544, Magdeburg 1583.
- *Drop them* when they foster superstition or blur the difference from the Mass: Regensburg 1554 and 1567, Transylvania 1557.
- *Forbid them* as contrary to God's word, which is the Reformed position, not an indifferent one: the Heidelberg Catechism, Kurpfalz 1565, the Casimirian mandate of 1587 (all Reformed).

2. Images: idols out, histories in (§14.4). The Lutheran orders remove only images that were prayed to or had lights burned before them, and keep scriptural histories as "the laity's Bible" (Brunswick 1528, Thüngen 1564, Oldenburg 1573, Regensburg 1567). Removal is to be orderly and by authority, never by the crowd:

- Strasbourg 1525 (Moderate Reformed) forbids citizens to touch anything.
- Mecklenburg 1552 nails the images to the walls.
- The Upper Palatinate in 1557 removes them by night, takes the carved figures out of mixed panels and blacks over the painted ones.

Kurland 1570 is the only order found that commissions new paintings: Old and New Testament histories, "especially of the resurrection and of the Last Judgement", for the native peasantry. Ulm 1531 (Moderate Reformed), the Heidelberg Catechism (Q. 98) and Kurpfalz 1565 (Reformed), and two Lutheran orders that follow them here, Lichtenberg 1579 and Sponheim 1590/91, reject the "laity's books" argument and clear images and crucifixes alike. The Prussian order of 1568 answers them by name.

3. The crucifix is the image the Lutheran orders most often name as kept (§14.4.5). Hannover 1536, Grubenhagen 1544 (where it "shall stand in the midst of the church") and Anhalt 1562 keep it. It is carried before funerals at Freiberg 1538 and Wolfstein 1574, stands at the deathbed (Dietrich 1545) and on the Mansfeld oath table (1586). The Reformed removed it, and the Lutheran Nassau-Weilburg in 1617 stopped carrying it before corpses. Banners, poles and processional crosses went with the processions (§14.4.6).

4. One altar; the minister before it, facing the people (§14.5.1–14.5.3). Side altars were removed, leaving three (Wittenberg 1522) or one (Mecklenburg 1552, Upper Palatinate 1557, Kurland 1570). Colditz 1529 and Gotha 1555 order altars arranged so that the minister faces the people. The Wittenberg theologians condemned standing *behind* the table as the disorder of Karlstadt and Müntzer (Radical Reformation) (Wittenbergische Reformation 1545, Allstedt 1533). Strasbourg 1537 (Moderate Reformed) set up an altar-table facing the people, and the Reformed orders put tables in place of altars (Siegen 1581, Casimir 1587, Anhalt 1596, Simmern 1598). In Transylvania the synod of 1565 ordered altars pulled down by "turbulent men" to be restored.

5. Two candles, no sacrament house (§14.5.4–14.5.5). The usual Lutheran altar has two lights during the Supper (Allstedt 1533, Calenberg 1544/45, Kurland 1570). Hildesheim 1544 explains them by the night of the Last Supper. Kurpfalz 1546 (Lutheran) keeps a single lamp, and Regensburg and Anhalt 1596 (Reformed) drop the lights. No order varies the number of lights by feast or season. Where the lights vary, they vary with communion: lit when there are communicants (Marggrabowa and Sensburg 1581), and at Suhl 1562 not lit at all. The endowments for the eternal light went to the common chest (Württemberg 1536), and the blessing of Candlemas and Easter candles was abolished (Hesse 1526, Moderate Reformed; Pfalz-Neuburg 1543, Lüneburg convents 1555). Since the Sacrament was not reserved, sacrament houses and ambries were emptied (Hesse 1526, Moderate Reformed; Schönburg 1542, Hohenlohe 1553) or removed (Pfalz-Neuburg 1560, Nassau-Weilburg 1576, Magdeburg 1583, Kurpfalz 1565 (Reformed)). No order uses "tabernacle" for a furnishing.

6. The font is moved into sight (§14.5.6). The customary font is kept (Prussia 1525), railed and adorned (Nördlingen 1544), and moved before the choir, raised a step or two (Lüneburg 1564), or "out of the corners before the face of the church" (Bentheim 1588, Reformed). Bremen 1534 warms the water in winter. The Reformed abolish the font (Kurpfalz 1565, Casimir 1587, Simmern 1598, all Reformed).

7. Pulpit, pews and galleries (§14.5.7). The pulpit appears among the things to be covered and kept. The choir screen is torn down at Zweibrücken 1558 so that the nuns can be seen at sermon. Saxony 1580 complains that pews block the view of pulpit and altar and forbids new pews without leave. Hadersleben 1571 rebuilds its pews to clear the aisle and separate men and women, and Thorn and Stargard have pew orders. Schoolboys sing from the north gallery at Wittenberg 1533. Guilds that once kept altars are to keep windows instead (Neumark 1540, Salzwedel 1579).

8. Paraments are covers, not a system (§14.6). No order names an antependium, dossal or pulpit fall, or prescribes colours. What the orders ask for:

- clean white linen on altar and font (Anhalt 1562, Wolfenbüttel 1569);
- covers made from old vestments for altar, pulpit and font, with a pall (Henneberg 1556), and the visitors are to ask whether altar, font, pulpit and desk are "covered as is due" (Leiningen 1609);
- a corporal and pall in the sick communion (Brandenburg 1540);

- the silk cloth held under communicants by boys, deacons or honest men (Hohenlohe 1553, Regensburg 1553, Speyer 1557, Thorn 1575). The Reformed Amberg mandate of 1567 abolished it, and so later did two Lutheran orders, the Upper Palatine visitation of 1579 under the Lutheran Elector Ludwig VI and Nassau-Weilburg 1617.

Surplus vestments were sold or cut up for the hospital's bed sheets (Schmiedeberg 1528), or made into altar cloths (Sponheim 1590/91). The Reformed exchanged chalices for beakers (Siegen 1581, Casimir 1587, Zweibrücken 1595, all Reformed).

The paten was kept as an ordinary vessel (Hannover 1536) and counted in the inventories (§14.6.7). The commonest rubric puts it, with as many hosts as communicants, into the minister's hand at the Words of Institution (Livonia 1533, the Palatinate 1546, Danzig 1557, Henneberg 1582). At the sick communion it was held under the communicant's chin (Brandenburg 1540). Havelberg (1558) forbade elevating it in the chalice's stead. Hohenlohe (1596) and Nassau-Weilburg (1617), both Lutheran, stopped showing or handling it at the Verba. The Reformed melted or sold patens with the chalices (Zweibrücken 1595, Wittgenstein 1605, both Reformed) and passed the bread in a dish.

9. Vestments: chasuble, cope, surplice (§14.7).

- *The Mass vestment* (alb and chasuble) was kept, and in Saxony restored, for the Supper with communicants: Leisnig 1529, Allstedt 1533, Grubenhagen 1544, Calenberg 1544/45, Thüngen 1564, Wolfenbüttel 1569, Thorn 1575. Riga 1530 and Kurland 1570 made a plain surplice the norm, with cope or chasuble on feasts.
- *The cope* replaced the chasuble when there were no communicants, so that the people should not think the private Mass had returned (Brandenburg 1540, Pfalz-Neuburg 1543). Brenz allowed it to the deacon at Schwäbisch Hall in 1527, but no chasuble, "neither man's nor woman's clothing".
- *Abolished:* the dalmatic and tunicle at Homberg 1526 (Moderate Reformed); the "Levite and Mass vestments" at Regensburg in 1554, with a reasoned statement read from the pulpit; the Mass vestment at Sayn 1575 and Anhalt 1596 (Reformed). Transylvania 1557 wants candles and *infulae* laid aside and a white linen garment instead.
- *The surplice* is the common minimum and the vestment most often named: Prussia 1543, Hesse 1532 (Moderate Reformed), Württemberg 1535 and 1553, the *Cellische Ordnungen* (Celle orders) of 1545, Regensburg 1554 and 1567, Wittgenstein 1563, Anhalt 1568. Ernestine Saxony and Coburg in 1554 limit it to the altar. The Palatine Calvinists (Reformed) and the Lutheran Sayn 1582 abolish it. Wild- und Rheingrafschaft 1603 introduces a black gown with sleeves, but keeps surplices where they are used.

10. Outside the service (§14.8). Ministers are to wear long, honest, priestly coats, not short, slashed or coloured clothes, so that they may be known as ministers (Grubenhagen 1544, the *Cellische Ordnungen* of 1545, Regensburg 1567, Wild- und Rheingrafschaft 1603).

11. Colours and the seasons (§14.6.6). No order prescribes liturgical colours or a seasonal change of vestments or paraments. Coloured vestments nonetheless stayed in use. In 1578 the Fürstenberg church had a red-and-green velvet chasuble newly given by the Duke of Mecklenburg, a red velvet chasuble and red damask deacon's coats. At Sorau the boys who held the communion cloths wore red smocks and green garlands. The Lenten veiling of images is named only to be ended: Luther rejects it, Mülhausen 1528 (Reformed) drops the unveiled crucifix shown on Good Friday, and at Regensburg a covered altarpiece was removed all the same. The Lenten veil, the Easter sepulchre, the paschal candle and the image plays of the feasts were all abolished (Luther 1526, Pfalz-Neuburg 1543, Hohenlohe 1553). Leiningen-Westerburg 1566 forbids May branches and decking the church with flowers as heathen customs; only at Hof (1592) did neighbours strew grass and set up May branches for the dedication procession. There is no Advent wreath or Christmas tree.

12. What is absent (§14.2.3). There is no evangelical mitre or crosier, and no preaching bands, cassock, rochet, biretta or episcopal insignia. Liturgical colours are never prescribed. The orders do not mention altar rails, credence tables, altars of repose, mosaics or stained-glass programmes, and say nothing of transepts, vaults, buttresses or undercrofts.

14.2 Scope, sources and method

14.2.1 Sources

The chapter draws on the full text of the Sehling edition in `eko.db`: the orders themselves, the visitation articles and decrees printed with them, and, where said, the editor's introductions and notes. It covers Lutheran, Upper German and Reformed orders alike, since the edition prints all three, and the Reformed clearances explain much of what the later Lutheran orders defend.

14.2.2 Searches

The corpus was searched with regular expressions for some thirty families of terms, in High and Low German and Latin spellings. Each hit was read in a window of context. The families, with the number of document-pages in which each was found, were:

- **Art:** *Bild* (image), *Bildnis* (likeness), *imago* (image), *statua* (statue) (752); *Gemälde* (painting), *Tafel* (panel), *Maler* (painter) (810); *Crucifix* (69); *Kreuz* (cross), *crux* (1,873, most of them the "cross" of suffering); *Fahne*, *Banner*, *vexillum* (80); *Fenster*, *Glasfenster* (93); *Reliquien*, *Heiltum* (227).
- **Building and furnishings:** *Altar* (1,951); *Kanzel* (pulpit), *Predigtstuhl* (pulpit) (1,266); *Taufstein* (font), *döpe* (font), *baptisterium* (baptistery) (562); *Lettner* (rood screen), *Gitter* (grille), *Schranken* (screens) (68); *Sakristei* (sacristy), *Gerbkammer* (vestry) (57); *Gestühl* (pews), *Kirchenstuhl* (church pew), *Bänke* (benches), *Empore* (gallery), *Borkirche* (gallery) (174); *Pult* (desk), *Lesepult* (lectern) (71); *Kerze* (candle), *Leuchter* (candlestick), *Ampel* (hanging lamp), *Lampe* (lamp) (222); *Beichtstuhl* (confessional) (17); *Sakramentshäuslein* (sacrament house), *Monstranz* (monstrance), *ciborium* (222); *Kirchturm* (118); *Kirchhof* (churchyard), *Gottesacker* (God's acre) (537).
- **Paraments and vessels:** *Altartuch* (altar cloth), *Corporal*, *Palla*, *Velum*, *Vorhang*, *Zwehle*, *Handtuch*, *lavabo*, *purificatorium* (purificator), *bursa* (burse) (244); *Ornat*, *Ornament* (ornament), *Zierat* (ornament), *Kleinod* (treasure) (331); *Kelch* (chalice), *calix* (chalice), *Patene* (paten) (1,112).
- **Vestments:** *Chorrock* (surplice), *Chorhemd* (surplice), *superpellicium* (surplice), *Röckel*, *Rochet* (262); *Meßgewand* (Mass vestment), *Casel* (chasuble), *casula*, *planeta* (196); *Alba*, *Humerale*, *Amictus*, *Stola*, *Manipel*, *Cingulum* (134); *Chorkappe*, *Chormantel*, *cappa*, *pluviale* (188); *Infel*, *Mitra*, *Bischofsstab*, *Krummstab* (crozier), *baculus* (staff) (110); *Dalmatik* (dalmatic), *Levitenrock* (levite's robe), *tunicella* (tunicle) (27); *Priesterkleid* (priest's garment), *Kirchenkleid* (church garment), *lange Röcke* (long gowns), *Schaube* (gown), *Talar* (gown), *Barett* (biretta) (155).

Further searches were made for the English terms of the request that have German equivalents: mosaic, narthex (*Vorhalle*, *Vorkirche*), transept (*Querschiff*), vault (*Gewölbe*), buttress, undercroft (*Krypta*, *Gruft*), credence (*Kredenz*), antependium, dossal, altar rail and kneeling bench (*Altargitter*, *Kniebank*), liturgical colours, preaching bands (*Beffchen*, *Kragen*), mitre and crosier.

A second pass searched for reservation and the seasons: tabernacle (*Tabernakel*), ambry (*armarium*, *Almer*, *Wandschrank* [wall cupboard], *Sakramentsnische* [sacrament niche]); colour words (*rot*, *grün*, *schwarz*, *violett*, *Farbe*) near vestments and cloths; the Lenten veil (*Hungertuch*, *Fastentuch*), the covering or veiling of images, crosses and altars (*decken*, *verdecken*, *verhüllen*, *velare*, *tegere*); the Easter sepulchre (*heiliges Grab*) and paschal candle (*Osterkerze*, *Osterstock*); Candlemas candles (*Lichtmeß*, *Kerzenweihe*); *Tenebrae* and *Finstermette* (Tenebrae); the eternal light (*ewiges Licht*); greenery and flowers (*Maien*, *Kirchen blümen*, *Gras streuen*, *Kranz*, *Tannenbaum*, *Christbaum*, *Krippe*); and lights named together with feasts, Sundays and weekdays.

14.2.3 What was not found

The searches came back empty, or with only incidental hits, for most of the architectural and episcopal vocabulary of the request:

- **Architecture.** No order regulates the nave, transept, vault, buttress, arch, steeple or undercroft. *Vorkirche* (porch) occurs, but in the sense of a gallery, where the boys are not to be suffered during the catechism (Ysenburg-Birstein 1588), or as one item in a list of parts to be kept in repair. *Querschiff* (transept) occurs once, in an editor's note. Towers, roofs, windows and churchyard walls appear only as fabric to be maintained, and bells are treated in Chapter 9.
- **Art.** No order mentions mosaics, or regulates what stained glass may show. Statues appear only as "carved images" to be removed or left. No order commissions a sculpture. The only new pictures ordered are Kurland's (§14.4.3).
- **Furnishings.** There is no altar rail, no credence table and no altar of repose. *Kredenz* occurs only as a letter of credence. Kneeling benches for communicants appear at Hohenlohe (§14.6.3) and, by the editor's report, at Hoya 1581. The rood screen appears only as the *Gitter* (grille) or *Schranken* (screens) to be removed (§14.5.7).
- **Paraments.** No antependium, frontal, superfrontal, dossal, reredos, runner, pulpit fall or lectern fall is named; the orders speak only of covers (*Decken*) for altar, pulpit, font and desk (§14.6.1). The corporal and pall appear once (§14.6.2). No order regulates the purificator, burse, chalice veil or lavabo towel. Font towels appear once (§14.5.6).
- **Seasons.** No order prescribes liturgical colours or seasonal changes; the colour sequence appears only in the editor's notes, and coloured vestments only in an inventory and a later report (§14.6.6). No order varies the number of candles by feast or season. *Tabernakel* never names a furnishing. No order prescribes veiling images or crosses in Lent or Passiontide; the veiling is mentioned only to be abolished (§14.6.6). There is no Advent wreath, Christmas tree, Easter garden or crib set up in church, and the Tenebrae hearse is never mentioned.

- **Vestments.** No order provides an evangelical mitre or crosier. The *Hirtenstab* occurs only as a metaphor for the preaching office, and Transylvanian *infulae* most likely means chasubles (§14.7.3). There are no preaching bands, cassock, cotta, cassock-alb, rochet, biretta, zucchetto, galero, humeral veil, pallium, rationale, gloves, tippet or hood. The amice and cincture are never named. The stole and maniple appear only to be left free (Hildesheim 1544) or dropped (Regensburg 1567), and the dalmatic and tunicle only to be forbidden (Hesse 1526, Moderate Reformed; Regensburg 1554). The black gown appears once, in 1603 (§14.7.4).

14.2.4 Method

Quoted passages were pulled from the database in full and checked as described in the conventions. Each page was checked against Sehling's running heads, which often correct the database's record headings. The most important corrections:

- the Bremen order is the *Kirchenordnung* (church order) of 1534, not the poor-chest order of 1525;
- the Mansfeld oath form belongs with the consistorial order of 1586;
- the Prussian surplice decree is the *Befehl* (command) of 1 February 1543, and the image passage is from the *Kirchenordnung und Ceremonien* (Church order and ceremonies) of 1568;
- the Sponheim passages are from the Hintere Grafschaft Sponheim (1590/91 and 1607), not Zweibrücken;
- the Palatine passage on images, altars and fonts is the Elector's *Befehl an die Amtleute* (Command to the officials) of 3 October 1565, printed after the Heidelberg Catechism.

The chapter quotes nearly a hundred passages from some eighty orders. It does not claim to list every mention of an altar or chalice, which number in the thousands, but every order found that says something distinctive on the questions asked is quoted or cited.

14.3 Things indifferent

14.3.1 The principle

Brandenburg-Nürnberg 1533. Every order that deals with these matters begins from the same place: vestments, cloths, vessels and lights are outward things, neither commanded nor forbidden by God. The Brandenburg-Nürnberg order of 1533 says it in a sentence. **Brandenburg-Nürnberg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1533** (Sehling 11, p. 183):

The other additions of outward, bodily things, as Mass vestment, altar covering, silver and golden vessels, lights, etc., are altogether free; they give and take nothing to faith and conscience.

Hannover 1536. Freedom did not mean abolition. The Hannover order lists what it keeps "in the freedom of the Spirit", for good order and for the weak: the priest's vestment at the altar, the customary vessels, lights on the altar, the crucifix and honest images, the font and the altar. **Hannover, *Kirchenordnung*, 1536** (Sehling 6/2, p. 1009):

For that cause will we also, for good order's sake and for the service of all the weak, still keep certain customary ceremonies, yet in the freedom of the Spirit: as the customary priestly clothing at the altar, the customary vessels which have been used hitherto for the handling of the holy sacraments, lights upon the altar, crucifix and honest images whereby no idolatry is practised, font, altar, Christian songs, German and Latin, according to the occasion of the time.

14.3.2 Keep what each church has

Magdeburg 1583. The rule most often given to visitors was to leave each church as it was. The Magdeburg instruction of 1583 lets Mass vestments, surplices, lights, altar cloths and the language of singing stand "as each church hath it in use", so that no unrest arise from changing, abolishing or setting up. Superstitious things are another matter: idolatrous images, the sacrament house and the monstrance are to go. **Magdeburg, *Instruktion zur Visitation*, 25 May 1583** (Sehling 2, p. 424):

Mass vestment, surplices, lights upon the altar, altar cloths, singing in Latin or in German, one shall let remain, to keep or not, as each church hath it in use, that hereby through changing, putting away or setting up no unrest be stirred up in churches, according to the saying of Christ: *Regnum Dei non venit cum observatione* (The kingdom of God cometh not with observation). But offensive, superstitious ceremonies, though they were old, shall be abolished, as idolatrous images to which some worship hath been applied, sacrament houses, monstrance.

14.3.3 Kept for peace and for the weak

Thüngen 1564. The Franconian lordship of Thüngen keeps Mass vestment and burning candles because they were in use "in Dr Martin's lifetime" at Wittenberg, in Meissen, Brandenburg and the chief imperial cities, and still are. The motive is peace and the weak, not any holiness in the things. **Thüngen, *Kirchenordnung*, 1564** (Sehling 11, pp. 736–737):

4. Of the Mass vestment and burning lights or candles. Forasmuch as the Mass vestment, as men call it, and the burning candles were in use in Dr Martin's lifetime in the churches of Wittenberg, of Meissen, of Brandenburg and of the chiefest imperial cities, and both are kept in the same unto this day, and with us for the most part both these pieces have been left unchanged, we will further keep them so in our churches for peace and unity's sake and because of the weak: not in the meaning that thereby any special worthiness or holiness befall the most worthy sacrament, or that it must needs be so, or yet that it be done to please the papists or to vex any other, but only for peace's sake and to prevent the offence of the weak.

Hildesheim 1544. The Hildesheim order keeps vestments and lights at the Sacrament on holy days "not as needful before God, but only as seemly before men", and only until all the evangelical churches agree to drop them. The stole and maniple it leaves to the preachers' freedom. **Hildesheim, *Christlike kerckenordeninge*, 1544** (Sehling 7/2.1, p. 852):

Now whereas many cities and lands which have received the gospel still keep such clothes and lights at the sacrament on the holy day only, not as needful before God but only as seemly before men, so will we also keep them, so long as until all others which have received the gospel put them away with one accord. Then will we also not be singular. If our preachers will not use the stoles and maniples, we ask nothing after that; it shall be free to them out of the same Christian liberty, as is said.

Hesse 1526 (Moderate Reformed). Even the Homberg synod of 1526, which forbade new purchases of vestments (§14.7.3), commended a minimum "that all things be done decently": the minister should at least wear a surplice, candles should be lit, and the chalice should be seemly. **Hesse, *Homberger Kirchenordnung*, 1526** (Moderate Reformed; Sehling 8, p. 45):

Let there be kept therein the rite which the servant of God Martin Luther last wrote in German; and that, according to Paul, all things be done the more decently, we commend it if in its ministry at the least a surplice be put on, candles be lighted, and a seemly chalice be had.

14.3.4 The limit

The same principle could cut the other way. Where a thing was used superstitiously, or where keeping it seemed to make no difference between the evangelical service and the Mass, it ceased to be indifferent and was to go. The Regensburg reasons of 1554 for dropping the Mass vestment (§14.7.3) and the Transylvanian synod of 1557 on candles and vestments (§14.7.3) both argue in this way. The Reformed orders went further and treated images, altars and fonts as forbidden in themselves (§§14.4.4, 14.5.3).

14.4 Images and crucifixes

14.4.1 Idols and histories

Brunswick 1528. The Lutheran orders do not condemn images as such. They condemn worship given to them. Bugenhagen's Brunswick order says that good books have been written showing it is not wrong to have images, especially those in which histories may be seen. The council has removed only those images before which people prayed and set lights; the rest stay, unless they too become objects of worship. **Brunswick, *Kirchenordnung*, 1528** (Sehling 6/1, p. 445):

Of images good books have been written, that it is not wrong nor unchristian to have images, especially those wherein one may see histories and deeds. We confess freely that we have in our churches many lying images and many unprofitable blocks. Yet, that we may not be image-stormers, and that other folk, known or strangers, may not look upon such as offensive, we have put away by ordinary power and authority only those images by and before which special worship and idolatry and special honour with lights and candlesticks was set up. All the others, which are no hindrance in the church, we let stand.

Pomesania 1525. The bishop of Pomesania's theses put the rule at its simplest: images are not to be prayed to, and no light is to be lit before them. **Pomesania, *Themata episcopi Risenburgensis*, 1525** (Sehling 4, p. 29):

16. The images in houses and churches one shall not pray to, nor light any light unto them.

The laity's Bible. The positive case came from Gregory the Great: pictures are the books of the unlettered. Thüngen 1564 removes idolatrous images "not agreeable to holy Scripture" and keeps those taken from both Testaments as "the laity's Bible and books"; pastors and sextons are to watch that no one, "especially the old women", misuse them for idolatry or sorcery. **Thüngen, *Kirchenordnung*, 1564** (Sehling 11, p. 739):

14. Of images and paintings. The idolatrous images which are not agreeable to holy Scripture shall one put away altogether, as becometh and behoveth right Christians and God's children. The others, which are taken out of holy Scripture, Old and New Testament, and serve the people for remembrance of true histories, for Christian doctrine and for example of many laudable virtues well-pleasing to God, those we let remain, and be, according to the saying of Gregory, the laity's Bible and books. Yet shall the pastors and sextons take good heed thereto, that no one (as alas happeneth too much, especially of the old women) misuse such tolerable images, grounded in God's word, either for idolatry or for sorcery.

Oldenburg 1573. The Oldenburg order answers those who say "the images in the churches are mere idolatry" with the same distinction, and quotes Gregory in Latin: *Quod legentibus est scriptura, hoc idiotis praestat pictura* (What writing is to them that read, a picture is to the unlearned). **Oldenburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1573** (Sehling 7/2.1, p. 1083):

But what are histories written in holy Scripture, of the patriarchs, of the apostles, and of the Lord Christ and his miracles, also his suffering, crucifying, dying, rising again, which are set forth in images, those may one have not only with good conscience but also with great profit in the churches and houses, for remembrance of the great benefits of God and for thanksgiving for the same.

Regensburg 1567. Regensburg, which had dropped the Mass vestment (§14.7.3), still took a middle way with images, as with the organ, figural music and Latin song: neither abolishing them altogether nor making too much of them. **Regensburg, *Kirchenordnung*, [1567]** (Sehling 13, p. 481):

With the images (even as also with more other things, as playing the organ, figural and Latin song) we hold (to show therein likewise the understanding of our Christian liberty) this mean: that we neither put them away altogether nor make too much of them; we make also the difference between those images and paintings which have certain good histories of Scripture and are not used for idolatry or superstition, and may otherwise give good, profitable remembrance, and the other manifold, popish, lying, idolatrous, unprofitable images and paintings.

The order goes on to say that the costly stone image of Mary and many wax figures of men and women, life-size, had already been removed "as Hezekiah did to the brazen serpent".

Gotha 1555 (Sehling 1, p. 569) likewise forbids "the idolatrous popish images which are not agreeable to biblical history". **Schweinfurt 1543** (Sehling 11, p. 630) follows Luther: where preachers lead the people from idolatry to Christ, "the images are already stormed and put away, so that no one regards them much"; images whose histories are uncertain and lying are to be removed by an ordinary magistrate. **Luther's *Deutsche Messe*** (Sehling 1, p. 16) wants Holy Week to be like other weeks, without "the hunger cloth, palm-shooting, covering of images and whatever more of the juggling-work there is".

14.4.2 Orderly removal

Strasbourg 1525 (Moderate Reformed). The orders insist that images be removed by authority, not by the people. The Strasbourg council's mandate of March 1525 forbids every citizen to take down anything, "small or great, in church or in the street", of images, altars, panels, iron or stone work, on pain of severe punishment; whoever has a grievance is to bring it to the council. **Strasbourg, *Mandat über Bilder und Altäre*, 18 March 1525** (Moderate Reformed; Sehling 20/1, p. 166):

Our lords the councillors and the Twenty-One command all and each of their burghers, spiritual and temporal, that they shall not of their own power and of themselves, together or severally, put away or break down anything, be it small or great, in churches or in the street, of images, altars, panels, iron or stone work, nothing at all excepted.

Mecklenburg 1552. The Mecklenburg visitors were to break down all altars but the high altar, use the stones for the church, nail the images to the walls, and take away offensive images and the ciboria. **Mecklenburg, *Visitations-Instruction*, 12 November 1552** (Sehling 5, p. 220):

the visitors shall ordain and give command to break down all the altars that are present over and above the high altar, to use the stones for the church, and to nail the images in the churches to the walls with nails, [and] to put away harmful and offensive images, and the ciboria.

Upper Palatinate 1557. The Upper Palatinate instruction orders idolatrous images removed by night, "without special tumult and clatter", by the officials. Where idolatrous figures stand on one panel with biblical histories, the carved figures are to be taken out and the painted ones blacked over. **Upper Palatinate, *Visitationsinstruktion*, 1557** (Sehling 13, p. 297):

Where also idolatrous images are together with biblical histories on one panel, the offensive carved images shall be taken out, and the painted ones painted over and smeared with black colour.

Grubenhagen 1544. The Grubenhagen order clears everything except the crucifix, which "shall stand and remain in the midst of the church", and the Christian panels over the altars. Side altars, idolatrous panels, candlesticks, banners, poles and screens are to be removed, sold, destroyed or locked away. **Grubenhagen, *Kirchenordnung*, 1544** (Sehling 6/2, p. 1034):

XV. Of the images in the church. All idols and images, excepting the image of the crucifix of our Lord Jesus Christ, which shall stand and remain in the midst of the church, together with the Christian panels over the altars: the others shall forthwith, together with the corner altars, idolatrous panels, candlesticks, banners, poles, screens and other popish foundations, be put away and cleared out, sold, destroyed or locked up, so that henceforth no one may practise his idolatry and hypocrisy before them.

Hermannstadt 1557. The Transylvanian Saxon synod of 1557 asks that "fabulous images and similar pictures" set up for worship be removed and sacred histories kept. **Hermannstadt, *Synodalbeschlüsse*, 1557** (Sehling 24, p. 262):

Seeing that in the churches here and everywhere fabulous images and like paintings are had, which are set up for worship against the manifest word of God prescribed in the Old and New Testament, it is altogether needful that they be taken away; but let sacred histories and the like, which teach and put in remembrance of a grave and serious matter, be retained.

14.4.3 New pictures

Kurland 1570. One order goes beyond tolerating old pictures and orders new ones. In Kurland the surplus altars and idolatrous images are to be cleared away, and in their place "other glorious histories out of the Old and New Testament, especially of the resurrection and of the Last Judgement", are to be painted "for the best of the poor non-Germans", that is, the native peasantry. **Kurland, *Kirchenordnung*, 1570** (Sehling 5, p. 98):

Our churches, together with the churchyards, shall be furnished cleanly, honestly and comely, and be kept in due manner, as is shown in the reformation; and in the churches [there shall be] not more than one altar, before which the most worthy sacrament must be ministered; the others, which are yet present, shall be cleared away and put away with all idolatrous images, and in their stead other glorious histories out of the Old and New Testament, especially of the resurrection and of the Last Judgement, shall be painted and ordained in Christian wise, for the best of the poor non-Germans.

14.4.4 The Reformed clearances

Ulm 1531 (Moderate Reformed). The Upper German and Reformed orders made no distinction between idols and histories. Ulm, under Bucer's hand, orders "such worshipped images" removed from all churches as soon as the people have been taught. **Ulm, *Kirchenordnung*, 1531** (Moderate Reformed; Sehling 17/2, p. 145):

So will we that such worshipped images be put away out of all churches and other places, so soon as the people is somewhat informed of the truth through the word, by the officials of each place, to whom we will give command thereof.

The Heidelberg Catechism. The Palatine catechism of 1563 (Reformed) refuses Gregory's argument outright. **Kurpfalz, *Heidelberger Katechismus*, Question 98, *Kirchenordnung*, 1563** (Reformed; Sehling 14, p. 362):

[98.] Question. But may not images be suffered in the churches as the laity's books? Answer. No; for we should not be wiser than God, who will not have his Christendom taught by dumb idols, but by the living preaching of his word.

Kurpfalz 1565 (Reformed). Two years later Frederick III ordered his officials to clear what remained: altars, Mount of Olives groups, crucifixes in church, in the street and before the church, sacrament houses, fonts and holy-water stoups. **Kurpfalz,**

***Befehl an die Amtleute*, 3 October 1565** (Reformed; Sehling 14, p. 429):

so we find still daily that yet here and there much idolatry is remaining, as namely altars, Mounts of Olives, idol-work, crucifixes in the church and on the streets, also before the churches, item sacrament houses, fonts, holy-water stoups, and more such idol-work.

The Reformed clearances that followed are quoted in §14.5.3: Nassau-Dillenburg's Siegen mandate of 1581 (images, panels, organs, altars and chalices), the Casimirian mandate of 1587 and Simmern 1598. Two Lutheran orders went the same way. The Sponheim *Kirchen- und Zensurordnung* (church and censure order) of 1590/91 (Sehling 18, p. 653) orders "crucifix and other images which are still present" taken away, and the Lichtenberg instruction of 1579, in Lutheran Pfalz-Zweibrücken, does the same for crucifixes. **Lichtenberg, *Dienstanweisung für die Pfarrer*, 1579** (Sehling 18, p. 379):

17.) Shall also the idolatrous images, crucifixes, where such are still present, according to the command of the visitation, be everywhere put away with discretion.

The Lutheran reply. The Prussian order of 1568 answers the "wretched Calvinists and enthusiasts", who think a man cannot be evangelical unless he storms all paintings and tears down all images. **Prussia, *Kirchenordnung und Ceremonien*, 1568** (Sehling 4, p. 73):

We can therefore also not hold with the wretched Calvinists and enthusiasts, which let themselves think that one cannot be evangelical unless one storm all paintings, tear down all images, put away all ceremonies, and let all things go rudely, indiscreetly, without discipline and order, one through another, like the unreasoning beast.

14.4.5 The crucifix

Kept and honoured. Hannover 1536 (§14.3.1) and Grubenhagen 1544 (§14.4.2) keep the crucifix by name. The Anhalt visitors of 1562 ordered pastors and churchwardens to keep altar and font clean, adorned with white linen cloths or tapestries, and to hold the Mass vestment and the crucifix "as a remembrance of the suffering of Christ" in comely state and honour. **Anhalt, *Kirchenordnung auf dem Lande*, 22 July 1562** (Sehling 2, p. 562):

Sixthly, we have also commanded all pastors and wardens that they keep their altar and font continually clean, adorn [them] with white linen cloths or tapestries, [and] hold their Mass vestment and whatever else belongeth to the use of the holy supper of Christ, and likewise also the crucifix, as a remembrance of the suffering of Christ done for us unto salvation, in comely state and in honour.

At funerals. The Freiberg visitation of 1538 orders a crucifix carried before every funeral, "especially to the honour of the high and comforting article of the resurrection of the dead". **Freiberg, *Visitation Verordnung und Artikel*, 1538** (Sehling 1, p. 468):

16. That one henceforth in every case carry a crucifix before at burial, especially to the honour of the high and comforting article of the resurrection of the dead.

Wolfstein 1574 permits it as a witness "on whom the Christians die". **Wolfstein, *Christliche Instructio des Thomas Stieber*, 1574** (Sehling 13, p. 586):

But to carry a crucifix before, for a witness on whom the Christians die, namely on the crucified Lord Jesus Christ, that shall be unforbidden.

The Nassau-Weilburg points of 1617, a Lutheran order, abolish the custom. **Nassau-Weilburg, *Erläuterungspunkte zur Kirchenordnung*, 1617** (Sehling 10, p. 353):

2. Where the crucifix hath hitherto been carried before the corpses, it shall also be put down, as in our other counties and lordships for the most part it hath long since fallen and remained [fallen].

At the deathbed. Veit Dietrich's Nuremberg *Agendbüchlein* (agenda booklet) allows a crucifix at the bedside of the dying but points beyond it. **Nuremberg, *Agendbüchlein Veit Dietrichs*, 1545** (Sehling 11, p. 522):

That one have a crucifix by the dying is not evil in itself. But whoso hath the comfort in the word, he hath the best crucifix, which not only the eyes can look upon, but the ears can grasp and the heart can image within itself.

On the oath table. In the Mansfeld consistory, oaths were sworn at a table covered with a black velvet pall bearing a white cross, with two great brass candlesticks and burning wax candles, a crucifix and the Bible. **Mansfeld, *Form und weise … mit den öffentlichen eidesleistungen*, appended to the consistorial order, 1586** (Sehling 2, p. 214):

7. The table is covered with a black velvet pall, which hath a white cross. 8. At the back upon the table, toward the court window, are set two great brass church candlesticks with two burning wax candles; further, upon the table a crucifix, and the Bible laid by it.

The form explains on the next page that the crucifix signifies Christ with the whole treasure of his merit, and the Bible all the promises of the gospel.

14.4.6 Banners, processional crosses and image plays

Banners (*Fahnen*), poles and processional crosses went with the processions they served. The Salza visitors of 1540 ordered the council to remove "all screens, candles, banners, idolatrous images and hindrances, and above all the altars save one" (Sehling 1, p. 654). Mecklenburg 1552 orders "the banners and crosses which one was wont to carry about in the papacy" taken out of the churches (Sehling 5, p. 220), and Grubenhagen 1544 lists "banners, poles" among the things to be removed (§14.4.2). Brunswick 1528 counts "lights, banners" among the needless splendour of baptism (Sehling 6/1, p. 356).

The image plays of the great feasts went with them. Hohenlohe 1553 abolishes the carrying about of the image of the risen Christ at Easter, its drawing up on Ascension Day, the letting down of the dove at Pentecost and the rocking of the Christ-child at Christmas (Sehling 15, p. 77; see Chapter 12, §12.10.10).

The rites of the feasts in which the image plays stood are treated in Chapter 13, §13.23.

14.5 The building and its furnishings

14.5.1 How many altars

Wittenberg 1522. The side altars served private Masses, and they went with them. The Wittenberg order of January 1522 is the earliest: images and altars are to be removed to avoid idolatry, "for three altars without images are enough". **Wittenberg, *Kirchen-Ordnung*, 1522** (Sehling 1, p. 697):

Item, the images and altars in the church shall also be put away, that idolatry may be avoided, for three altars without images are enough.

One altar. Later orders keep a single altar for the Supper. Kurland 1570 allows "not more than one altar" (§14.4.3), and its sexton prepares only that altar, "since no other or more altars are to be used, much less to be permitted after popish custom" (Sehling 5, p. 87). Mecklenburg 1552 keeps the high altar alone (§14.4.2), and the Upper Palatinate instruction of 1557 orders "all altars save one, whereon one holdeth the Lord's Supper" taken away (Sehling 13, p. 297). Salza 1540 does the same (Sehling 1, p. 654).

Württemberg 1536. Where a church still had several altars, Württemberg let the minister choose the most convenient. **Württemberg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1536** (Sehling 16, p. 107):

choose such an altar for the Supper as may be the most convenient of all, where one may go to and from most commodiously and hear all things most plainly; which altar also shall be furnished with bread and wine as need requireth.

Hermannstadt 1565. In Transylvania the danger ran the other way. The synod of 1565 forbids the altars to be destroyed, and where "turbulent men" have pulled them down, pastors are to see them restored without tumult. **Hermannstadt, *Synodalartikel*, 1565** (Sehling 24, p. 293):

Let the altars in no wise be pulled down; but if anywhere in our churches they have been pulled down by turbulent men, let godly pastors take pains that they be restored without tumults. And testimonies of the primitive church are extant that the Lord's Supper was administered not on wooden tables but on altars.

14.5.2 Where the minister stands

Facing the people. Several Saxon visitations order the altars arranged so that the minister faces the people. **Colditz, *Verordnung der Visitatoren*, 1529** (Sehling 1, p. 545):

Tenthly, that the altars be so arranged, that the minister may perform all his church office toward the people.

Gotha, *Artikel der Visitatoren*, 1555 (Sehling 1, p. 569):

Secondly, that the idolatrous popish images which are not agreeable to biblical histories be not suffered in the church; also that the altars shall be so arranged, that the priests may perform their office with the face turned toward the people.

Not behind the table. "Facing the people" did not yet mean standing behind a freestanding table. That posture was associated with Karlstadt and Müntzer (Radical Reformation), and the Wittenberg theologians condemned it. The *Wittenbergische Reformation* of 1545 hopes for a uniform Mass "with standing before the altar, that there be not such disorder as in some places, that the priests stand behind the table" (Sehling 1, p. 214). The Allstedt visitation of 1533, in Müntzer's former parish, orders every pastor to celebrate "not behind the altar, as some have done from the time of Thomas Müntzer until now, but to stand before the altar", and not to turn to the people at the elevation (Sehling 1, p. 510).

Behind the table. At the end of the century the Reformed princes ordered exactly that. In Anhalt in 1596 Johann Georg ordered the ministers to lay aside lights, Mass vestments and chasubles, to step behind the table "be it of stone or of wood", face the people and break the bread; the village officers were to remove the panels from the altars and the carved crucifixes from the churches, and set up a table in place of the altar. **Anhalt, *Verordnung Johann Georgs*, 3 November 1596** (Reformed; Sehling 2, p. 580):

[that he] shall lay aside the lights upon the altars, Mass vestment and chasubles; at the administering and dealing out of the holy Supper of the Lord step behind the table (be it of stone or of wood), turn the face to the people, and break the hallowed bread at the distribution, and give the same to the people according to Christ's word and institution; and that the village headmen and wardens put away the panels from the altars and the carved wooden crucifixes out of the church, and in place of the altar a table of stone or of wood [set up].

Strasbourg 1537 (Moderate Reformed) had already set up an "altar-table" facing the people so that everyone might hear every word. **Strasbourg, *Agende*, 1537** (Moderate Reformed; Sehling 20/1, p. 270):

the pastor cometh and goeth before the altar-table, which they have caused to be set up toward the people, that every man may perceive all the words, and beginneth the common office with the following words.

14.5.3 Tables in place of altars

The Reformed princes replaced altars with tables outright. **Simmern, *Mandat zur Abschaffung der Bilder und Altäre*, 2 October 1598** (Reformed, issued from Heidelberg after Simmern fell to the Electoral Palatinate; Sehling 19/2, p. 661):

that in this whole district of Simmern, everywhere in the churches, the idol-work, altars, fonts and the like shall be wholly abolished, and in the altars' stead ordinary tables be ordained.

The Casimirian mandate for the Palatinate in 1587 (Reformed) is a list of such measures. **Kurpfalz, *Casimirianische Kirchenordnung*, mandate, 1587** (Reformed; Sehling 19/2, p. 757):

13. In place of altars one shall cause wooden tables to be made and set in the church. 14. No font shall be suffered in the church. 15. In place of the little round hosts one shall set broad cakes or loaves in a dish upon the table in the church.

The Siegen mandate of 1581 (Reformed) likewise orders "the actual abolition of the idols, panels, organs, altars, chalices, and the ordering in their stead in each place of a table and a beaker" (Sehling 10, p. 158).

Altar or table. The Lutheran order of Marienhafe in East Frisia (1593), surrounded by Reformed churches, uses both words: each church is to have its own table-cloth, chalice, dish and can, "to use cleanly upon the altar or table of the Lord". **Marienhafe, *Kirchenordnung*, 1593** (Sehling 7/1, p. 710):

For the holy Supper of the Lord each church shall have its own table-cloth, chalice, dish and can, to use finely and cleanly upon the altar or table of the Lord. And the communicants shall receive it kneeling: at one end of the altar or table the blessed bread, at the other the cup, with due reverence and devotion.

14.5.4 Lights

Two candles. The commonest Lutheran arrangement was two candles on the altar during the Supper. Allstedt 1533 orders "two burning lights during Mass" with alb and chasuble (§14.7.1), and the Calenberg synods of 1544/45 "two lights set upon the altar" (§14.7.1). Kurland 1570 has the sexton light both wax candles on the altar and a third on the pulpit, and forbids other lights by day. **Kurland, *Kirchenordnung*, 1570** (Sehling 5, p. 87):

then the sexton prepareth the altar, which is ordained only for the service of God and the most worthy sacrament, since no other or more altars are to be used, much less to be permitted after popish custom; he lighteth also upon the altar the two wax candles, as hath always been the use in these lands; likewise upon the pulpit he lighteth the third light; else shall no other lights in broad day be used or permitted, by Germans or non-Germans, after their idolatrous custom.

Lights at the Supper. The Hildesheim order of 1544 tells how an evangelical preacher, mocked for lighting candles on the altar in broad day, answered that Christ held his last supper at night in a hall full of lights. **Hildesheim, *Christlike kerckenordeninge*, 1544** (Sehling 7/2.1, p. 852):

An evangelical preacher was asked in mockery: Wherefore light ye lights upon the altar in the light of day, when ye can well see without lights? The preacher found a good answer straightway and spake: We hold there the Lord's Supper. Christ held his last supper and gave the sacrament in the night in which he was betrayed; there were many lights in the great hall because of the dark night. So we also now light lights, not for need's sake in clear day, but to signify and betoken that we hold there not a midday meal or eating, but that same evening meal.

Wolfenbüttel 1569. The Brunswick-Wolfenbüttel order wants the altar adorned with clean cloths and lights burning "because this is also kept in the neighbouring reformed churches", the people being taught that it is a free thing without superstition. **Brunswick-Wolfenbüttel, *Kirchenordnung*, 1569** (Sehling 6/1, p. 143):

The altar also shall be adorned and clothed with clean cloths and other ornaments; item, lights shall burn upon the altar, because the same is kept also in the neighbouring reformed churches; and yet the common people may be informed that such is not necessary, as though any special service of God stood therein or the hallowing of this sacrament lay thereon, but that it is kept as a free indifferent thing without all superstition.

Here "reformed" means the neighbouring evangelical churches, not the Calvinists. **Ansbach 1548**, an Interim order, wants the altar candles lit at the beginning of Mass and Vespers and not put out until the very end (Sehling 11, p. 327). Thüngen 1564 keeps them for peace (§14.3.3).

One lamp. The Palatine provisional order of 1546 (Lutheran; not an Interim order) reduces the lights to a single lamp and turns the cost of oil and wax to other uses. **Kurpfalz, *Gemaine maß, die kirchen- und gottesdinst anzurichten*, 1546** (Sehling 14, p. 94):

7. One shall leave only one lamp in the church, [and] put down the remaining cost of oil and wax [and] use [it] for other needful services of the church.

Abolished. Regensburg dropped the lights with the Mass vestment (§14.7.3), and Anhalt in 1596 (Reformed) ordered them laid aside (§14.5.2).

Lights for the Supper, not for the feast. No order found varies the number of altar lights by the rank of a feast or by the season. Where the orders vary the lights, they vary them by whether the Supper is held. In the Prussian towns the lights are lit with the Mass vestment when there are communicants, and on other Sundays the minister wears only the surplice. **Marggrabowa, *Gottesdienstordnung*, 1581** (Sehling 4, p. 149):

In ceremonies he shall begin nothing new, and at all times, when communicants are present, use the Mass vestment [and] cause the lights upon the altar to be lit; and when no communicants are present, use the surplice at all times on the Sundays.

The Sensburg order of the same year has the same words (Sehling 4, p. 151). At Suhl in Henneberg, by contrast, the whole Sunday service with communion, two and a half hours of ringing, singing, reading, preaching and communion, was held without any lights. **Suhl, *Ordnung des predigamts und lektionen*, 1562** (Sehling 2, p. 351):

All this is done without lights, and lasteth, with ringing, singing, reading, sermon and communion, about two hours and a half.

The Gottorf visitors of 1587 still had to ask, parish by parish, whether the candles were lit or removed. **Gottorf, *Visitationsartikel*, 1587** (Sehling 23, p. 371):

11. Whether the church vesture, linen as well as silk, be in use at the administration of the Supper or abolished; [whether] the candles be lighted or removed.

Lights for the dark. Other lights were plainly practical. In the Neumark the guilds, which had burned candles every Sunday and feast day, were to give wax yearly instead, so that the church might have light "in the winter when the day is short". **Neumark, *Kasten-Ordnung*, 1 March 1540** (Sehling 3, p. 32):

Whereas also the great and small crafts formerly burned lights on the candles every Sunday and feast day, the councils shall likewise treat with the crafts to give a certain quantity of wax yearly, that in winter, when the day is short, lights may be had and used for the need of the church.

The eternal light. The endowments for the perpetual lamp went into the common chest with the endowments for Masses and vigils. **Württemberg, *Kastenordnung*, 1536** (Sehling 16, p. 96):

First, of steady and certain income there shall be put together and drawn into one chest all that hath hitherto been spent on Masses, vigils, the eternal light, wax and oil.

The Württemberg order of 1552 repeats the clause (Sehling 16, p. 202). The single lamp of Kurpfalz 1546, which the editor takes for the eternal light, is the only one found kept.

Blessed candles. The blessing of candles at Candlemas was abolished. **Hesse, *Homberger Kirchenordnung*, 1526** (Moderate Reformed; Sehling 8, p. 49):

But we forbid in the power of almighty God that anyone do on these feasts any of those things which have hitherto been brought in against the purity of the words of God, as are the blessing of candles on the day of the Presentation, and the superstitions which were observed on the other days prescribed.

Brandenburg 1540 drops the blessing of "herbs, lights and other things" (Sehling 3, p. 88). Schweinfurt 1543 has the Candlemas preacher lead the people "from the folly and idolatry which they formerly had with the lights" to Christ, "the true, eternal light" (Sehling 11, p. 635). Pfalz-Neuburg 1543 forbids blessing the paschal candle (*osterstock*) with the Easter fire (§14.6.6), and the Lüneburg convent reform of 1555 stops the prioress's blessing of palms, Easter candles, water and fire. **Lüneburg, *Reformatio coenobiorum*, 1555** (Sehling 6/1, p. 615):

Since then the prioress for a time hath hallowed the palms, Easter candles, water and fire, and yet such belongeth not to her, for they are without that God's good creatures, and there is no command thereof in holy Scripture, but rather it is contrary thereto, so shall the same henceforth be left off.

Tenebrae. The Holy Week *Tenebrae* survived in the Lutheran orders only as the responsory *Tenebrae factae sunt* (Darkness fell), sung on Fridays or Good Friday, and in places as a Friday bell. No order keeps the hearse of candles put out one by one. Pfalz-Neuburg 1543 keeps the three Holy Week Matins "but without any knocking, rumbling and din" (Sehling 13, p. 95), the noise that ended the office in the dark.

14.5.5 The sacrament house

The evangelical orders gave communion at once and did not reserve the Sacrament, so the sacrament house lost its purpose. Hohenlohe 1553 forbids the Sacrament to be "kept, locked up or carried about" (Sehling 15, p. 77). **Schönburg, *Kirchen-Ordnung* of Johann Pfeffinger, 18 October 1542** (Sehling 2, p. 175):

9. They shall keep no sacrament nor chrism or the like in the sacrament house, nor suffer burning lamps before it.

Ambries. The Homberg synod (Moderate Reformed) forbids reservation in any form, "in ambries or little boxes". **Hesse, *Homberger Kirchenordnung*, 1526** (Moderate Reformed; Sehling 8, p. 46):

[27] Because the use of the holy eucharist is the receiving of it, and the communion of the faithful in remembrance of Christ, let it henceforth nowhere be reserved in ambries or little boxes, and by no means be carried about. For these are figments of men, and therefore to be shunned.

No order uses "tabernacle" (*Tabernakel*) for a furnishing. The word occurs only for the tabernacle of Israel and in the psalms.

Removal. The Pfalz-Neuburg visitation of 1560 counts sacrament houses and altars not used for communion among "idolatrous images", to be removed "with Christian discretion", as in the Upper Palatinate. **Pfalz-Neuburg, *Visitationsordnung*, 1560** (Sehling 13, p. 135):

So are we informed that idolatrous images, as sacrament houses and altars which are not used for the communion, are still in some churches. There shall our visitors think upon means and ways, whether and how such images and other things which can give cause for idolatry may be abolished with Christian discretion.

Nassau-Weilburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1576 (Sehling 10, p. 310), joins them with the ossuary:

27. Hither belong also the remaining dead men's bones [= ossuary] and the so-called saints' and also sacrament houses, which one shall wholly abolish, and bury and inter the dead men's bones in the earth in the churchyard.

Magdeburg 1583 (§14.3.2) and Kurpfalz 1565 (Reformed; §14.4.4) name the sacrament house too.

14.5.6 The font

Kept. The Prussian order of 1525 baptizes in plain water "in the customary font, which may be renewed as often as is needful". **Prussia, *Artikel der ceremonien und anderer kirchen ordnung*, 10 December 1525** (Sehling 4, p. 33):

Baptism shall be done in the church as before, only in pure water, kept therefor in the customary font, which may be renewed as oft as it is needful; and it needeth not the old Easter ceremonies, nor any oil or chrism.

Moved to sight. Baptism was to be public, and the font was moved accordingly. Lüneburg 1564 sets the fonts "up before the choir and a step or two high". **Lüneburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1564** (Sehling 6/1, p. 554):

Therefore we ordain and appoint that in all parishes of our principality the fonts, where it hath not already been done, shall be set up before the choir, and a step or two on high.

Bentheim-Tecklenburg 1588 (Reformed) moves the fonts "out of the corners before the face of the church, as hath been done also in many reformed churches of the German nation". **Bentheim-Tecklenburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1588** (Reformed; Sehling 22, p. 268):

The baptisteries or fonts also shall be moved out of the corners before the face of the church, as hath been done also in many reformed churches of the German nation.

Adorned. Kaspar Löner at Nördlingen asks the council to rail the font about and adorn it. **Nördlingen, *Kirchenordnung Kaspar Löners*, 1544** (Sehling 12, p. 314):

Thereto is also my request, that your honourable wisdom will cause the font to be railed about and adorned.

Kurland 1570 wants "a special, glorious font or font-vessel, with the needful two towels and cloths" (Sehling 5, p. 99).

Warm water. Bremen 1534 tells the sexton to provide warm water in a basin in frosty weather, so that baptism, given for salvation, does the child's body no harm. **Bremen, *Kirchenordnung*, 1534** (Sehling 7/2.2, p. 439):

In winter, when it is frozen, one shall tell the sexton that he provide warm water (not to his own harm and hurt) in a basin, that the baptism, given for salvation, harm not the little child in its body.

Abolished. The Reformed orders removed the font altogether: Kurpfalz 1565 (§14.4.4), the Casimirian mandate of 1587 and Simmern 1598 (§14.5.3), all Reformed. The Lutheran Sponheim in 1607 complains that the "old, abolished fonts and corner-Mass altars" ordered removed still lie broken in some churches, "a great unseemliness" (Sehling 18, p. 669).

14.5.7 Pulpit, screens, pews, galleries and windows

The pulpit. The orders say little of the pulpit's form. It appears with altar and font as a thing to be covered (§14.6.1) and kept, and in Kurland it bears the third light (§14.5.4).

The choir screen. The Zweibrücken visitation of 1558 orders the screen in the nuns' choir "torn away", so that the preacher can see that they hear the sermon. **Pfalz-Zweibrücken, *Visitationsordnung*, 1558** (Sehling 18, p. 270):

But in the meantime, until such change be undertaken, they shall be earnestly held to hear the preaching of God's word; and that one may be sure of them, that the same be attended by all of them, the grating in the choir shall be torn away from them, that they may be seen by a preacher and could not withdraw themselves.

Salza 1540 removes "all screens" (*gitter*) with the side altars, and Grubenhagen 1544 lists *schranken* among the things to be cleared (§14.4.2).

Pews. By the later sixteenth century the nave was filling with pews, and the orders regulate them. Electoral Saxony in 1580 complains that pews built "here and there" block the view of the pulpit and of the altar at communion. **Saxony, *Ordnung Herzog Augusts*, 1580** (Sehling 1, p. 451):

XXXVI. Of the pews in the church. Whereas also a common complaint hath come in, that here and there pews are built into the churches, whereby the people are hindered, that they can see neither the preacher in the pulpit nor [toward] the altar when the most worthy sacrament is dealt out; likewise also oftentimes such pews are set up in the common gangways, so that the people cannot well go to and fro before them: therefore in the churches in the villages and towns henceforth no pew shall be built without the special knowledge and leave of the pastor and the churchwardens.

No pew is to be hereditary; it is granted only for the holder's lifetime. At Hadersleben in 1571 Duke Johann ordered the old pews in the church torn out and new ones built, because a corpse could not be carried up the middle of the church and men and women stood mixed on both sides. **Hadersleben, *Mandat zu den Kirchenstühlen*, 31 May 1571** (Sehling 23, p. 242):

Whereas our cathedral church at Hadersleben is so built up with pews that one cannot come with any corpse up the middle of the church, but must bring the same with great trouble by other ways round about to its resting-place; also this disorder is found besides, that men and women persons stand one among another on both sides.

Thorn (1599) and Stargard (1596) have whole pew orders (Sehling 4, pp. 244, 520–521).

Galleries. The Wittenberg order of 1533 sends the schoolboys who cannot fit into the stall in the middle of the church up the tower stair to "the north gallery", to sing with those below and keep quiet. **Wittenberg, *Kirchen-Ordnung*, 1533** (Sehling 1, p. 704):

but with the others, which cannot come into the stall, a school servant shall go in order into the tower door and climb in all quietness up to the gallery toward midnight, there to sing with what is sung beneath, [and] also look diligently that the children be still, hear the sermon, and do no knavery.

Saxony 1580 forbids "levity and mischief with laughing, chattering or the like" on the galleries (Sehling 1, p. 440).

Windows. In the Neumark the craft guilds, which had once kept altars with their panels and candlesticks, were each to keep up one window in the parish church instead. **Neumark, *Kasten-Ordnung*, 1 March 1540** (Sehling 3, p. 32):

The windows. Whereas of old the crafts in towns commonly had special foundations granted to them, whereto they had to maintain an altar with panels, candlesticks and other altar-gear, we think it good that the council of each town treat with its crafts, that in return each craft maintain a particular window in the parish church for ever.

Salzwedel 1579 and other Brandenburg visitations order the council to make the guilds repair the windows they were wont to keep (Sehling 3, p. 285). Nothing is said of what the glass showed.

14.6 Paraments, linens and vessels

14.6.1 Covers for altar, pulpit and font

White linen. The orders seldom name individual paraments. What they ask for is that altar, pulpit and font be decently covered and clean. Anhalt 1562 wants altar and font "adorned with white linen cloths or tapestries" (§14.4.5), and Wolfenbüttel 1569 the altar "adorned and clothed with clean cloths and other ornaments" (§14.5.4).

Henneberg 1556. The Henneberg visitors at Römhild ordered fine covers made "from the ornaments", that is, from the old vestments, for altar, pulpit and font, with a funeral pall and a fine little cloth for the communicants. **Henneberg, *Abschied der Visitatoren für die Superintendenz zu Römhild*, 20 December 1556** (Sehling 2, p. 328):

Eleventhly, in all churches to cause fine covers to be made from the ornaments, about the altar, pulpit, font; a pall; a fine little cloth for the communicants.

The Leiningen-Hardenburg visitation articles of 1609 ask the visitors to inquire whether "their altar, font, pulpit, desk, etc., are covered as is due". **Leiningen-Hardenburg, *Visitations- und Täuferordnung*, 1609** (Sehling 19/1, p. 315):

42. Whether their altar, font, pulpit, desk, etc., be covered as is due?

The reading desk (*Pult*) appears here among the furnishings to be covered. No order names a lectern fall, superfrontal, dossal or runner.

Old vestments made into altar cloths. The Sponheim order of 1590/91, a Lutheran order, turns surplices and Mass vestments into altar cloths, and gives what is of little use to the poor. **Hintere Grafschaft Sponheim, *Kirchen- und Zensurordnung*, 1590/91** (Sehling 18, p. 653):

15. Crucifix and other images which are still present one shall put away and abolish; surplices or choir shirts and Mass vestments shall be made up into altar cloths; but where they are of little use or not to be used, one is to give it to poor folk.

14.6.2 Corporal and pall

Brandenburg 1540. The corporal and pall appear in the rite for the sick. The priest is to have a special chalice kept for the purpose, a corporal, the hosts in a case, a vessel for wine, "a special pall wherewith to cover the table further", a surplice and a light. **Brandenburg, *Kirchen-ordnung*, 1540** (Sehling 3, p. 80):

But the priest shall have a special chalice, ordained thereto, in a convenient place, together with a corporal, and in a case the particles, thereto also a vessel for the wine, also a special pall wherewith to cover the table further; item also a surplice and light.

No order in the corpus regulates the purificator, burse, chalice veil, lavabo or credence. The lavabo went with the offertory, which the evangelical orders dropped.

14.6.3 The communion cloth

Held by boys or men. Many Lutheran orders kept the cloth held under the communicants' chins, "to prevent mishap". At Hohenlohe two honest men go to the altar with a silk cloth and little kneeling benches. **Hohenlohe, *Kirchenordnung*, 1553** (Sehling 15, p. 71):

Then shall two honest men betake themselves to the altar with a silken little cloth and small benches, whereon the communicants kneel down.

At Regensburg under Justus Jonas the deacons hold it in surplices. **Regensburg, *Kirchenordnung unter Justus Jonas*, 1553** (Sehling 13, p. 421):

But the deacon who is third holdeth the little cloth on the side of the priest who reacheth the body. But he that is fourth holdeth the little cloth by the deacon who reacheth the blood, in a surplice.

At Speyer two boys hold the cloths "for the more reverence's sake". **Speyer, *Kirchenordnung*, 1557** (Sehling 19/1, p. 92):

whereto two boys, which hold the little cloths for more reverence's sake, shall be used.

At Thorn boys stand on both sides of the altar with silk cloths, while the priests minister in chasuble and surplice. **Thorn, *Kirchenordnung*, 1575** (Sehling 4, p. 237):

Under this the priests stand, as in the whole office, clad in the customary church clothes, chasuble and surplice, and reach to the people the sacrament of the body and blood of Jesus Christ; where also on both sides of the altar boys stand, which hold silken little cloths, to prevent mishap.

Abolished. The Palatine Calvinists (Reformed) abolished the cloth with the surplice. **Kurpfalz, *Amberger Mandat*, 20 January 1567** (Reformed; Sehling 13, p. 303):

Secondly, that the little cloth which is held under the communicants be abolished.

The Upper Palatinate visitation of 1579, a Lutheran order of Elector Ludwig VI, orders both things dropped; *verbleiben* here means "be left off", as the editor notes. **Upper Palatinate, *Visitationsordnung*, 1579** (Sehling 13, p. 315):

3. That the surplice and the little cloths shall henceforth be left off altogether, as the Electoral Palatinate hath expressly declared itself thereto upon the excuse of some touching the surplice.

When the parish of Sallern resisted, the elector ordered the abolition carried through, but only after the superintendent or pastor had preached to the people "concerning things indifferent" (Sehling 13, p. 315). Nassau-Weilburg in 1617 abolishes the cloth "still held before the communicants in a few places". **Nassau-Weilburg, *Erläuterungspunkte zur Kirchenordnung*, 1617** (Sehling 10, p. 351):

4. We are informed that still in some few places a little cloth is held before the communicants as they go to the Lord's table; the same shall herewith be abolished.

14.6.4 The stock of vestments

Inventories. The first Saxon visitations dealt with paraments as property. At Schmiedeberg in 1528 two chalices and the three best Mass vestments are kept for the Mass; the albs are cut up for bed sheets in the hospital, and the rest sold for the common chest. **Schmiedeberg, *Verordnung der Visitatoren*, 1528** (Sehling 1, p. 664):

Two chalices and three Mass vestments, the best, shall be kept for the use of the Mass; what there is of albs, cut up [and] given into the hospital for bed sheets for the need of the poor; and the remaining albs and chasubles sold, and the purchase money [put] into the common chest.

Zahna 1528 has the same provision (Sehling 1, p. 713).

No new purchases. The Homberg synod (Moderate Reformed) forbids any further outlay on altar paraments, chasubles, copes or mantles; what was spent on them is to go to the poor. A minister who has a chasuble may use it at the Supper or not. **Hesse, *Homberger Kirchenordnung*, 1526** (Moderate Reformed; Sehling 8, p. 45):

[22] From henceforth let no outlays be made for the paraments of altars, chasubles, copes or mantles and the like; but let that which was wont to be spent in vain on these be dispensed rather to the needy. Truly, he that thinketh to worship God in these doeth it without cause, for they are pure and vain traditions of men. But let it be free to him that hath a chasuble to use the same in the ministry of the Lord's Supper or not; yet for the rest let them by no means be bought.

14.6.5 Chalices and beakers

Two chalices. Kurland 1570 wants two chalices in every parish, "one for the healthy, the other for the sick" (Sehling 5, p. 99), and Brandenburg 1540 a separate chalice for the sick (§14.6.2).

Beakers. The Reformed replaced chalices with beakers. The Casimirian mandate of 1587 (Reformed) orders all but one of the chalices sent to the treasury and silver beakers used instead (Sehling 19/2, p. 757), and Siegen 1581 (Reformed) orders "a table and a beaker" (§14.5.3). At Zweibrücken in 1595, now Reformed, all chalices and patens were to be collected after Easter and handed to the goldsmiths to make beakers "for the more conformity with other reformed evangelical churches". **Pfalz-Zweibrücken, *Mandat zur Ablieferung der Vasa sacra*, 7 April 1595** (Reformed; Sehling 18, p. 410):

Whereas also in stead of the chalices, which hitherto have been used in administering the holy Supper, henceforth, for the sake of more conformity with other reformed evangelical churches, according to the order herewith coming, silver beakers shall be used: so is herewith our gracious command, that ye lay upon the church steward of your committed district to bring together all chalices together with the patens, be they of what material they will.

14.6.6 Colours and the seasons

No sequence of colours. No order in the corpus prescribes liturgical colours, or a change of vestments or paraments by season or feast. The only accounts of the seasonal colour sequence are the editor's notes on the chasuble (for example Sehling 6/1, p. 424). Riga 1530 allows a cope or chasuble on the high feasts over the plain surplice, and Kurland 1570 "other silken vestments, chasubles, Mass vestment" on the high feasts "for a change" (§14.7.1). Neither says anything of colour.

Coloured vestments in use. Inventories show that coloured vestments remained in use and were even given new. The Mecklenburg visitors of 1578 found at Fürstenberg a red-and-green velvet chasuble that Duke Johann Albrecht had given that very summer, a red velvet chasuble, two red damask deacon's coats and two brass candlesticks on the altar. **Mecklenburg, *Ordnung der Visitatoren für Fürstenberg*, 1578** (Sehling 5, p. 265):

Inventory. Three silver gilt chalices. Two silver gilt patens. A red and green parted velvet chasuble with small gilt clasps, the cross on the back, with the other appurtenances; the same hath my gracious prince and lord, lord Johann Albrecht, etc., given into the church at Fürstenberg this present summer. A red velvet chasuble together with its appurtenances. Two other old chasubles besides, which are not used. Two red damask deacon's coats set with gilt borders; and otherwise the linen cloth which is needfully used for the altar. Two brass candlesticks on the altar.

At Sorau in Lower Lusatia, the boys who held the communion cloths wore red choir smocks and green wreaths on their heads. The extract of the Sorau order of 1595 is known only from a chronicle of 1710, which lists it among customs "named therein and since fallen out of use". **Sorau, *Kirchenordnung*, extract after J. S. Magnus, 1595** (Sehling 3, p. 372):

1. On high feast days all persons who were in the church, men and women, young and old, went to the offering. 2. After the consecration of the bread and wine was done at the holy Supper, the elevation was in use. 3. The boys who held the little cloths at the sides of the altar had red choir smocks and green garlands upon their heads.

The only other colours prescribed are those of mourning and penance: the black velvet pall with a white cross on the Mansfeld oath table (§14.4.5), and the black cloths hired out for funerals at Breslau in 1528 (Sehling 3, p. 399).

Veiling in Lent and Holy Week. The Lenten veiling of images is mentioned in only a handful of places in the corpus, and always in order to end it. Luther's *Deutsche Messe* (German Mass) rejects the Lenten veil ("hunger cloth") and the covering of images (§14.4.1). No order keeps either, and none prescribes veiling crosses or images in Passiontide.

The Mülhausen preachers' opinion on Holy Week of 1528 (Reformed) shows the other end of the veiling: the crucifix unveiled and shown at the Good Friday office. They ask that this "may well be left off, with some chants", together with the burial of the Lord in the sepulchre and the wooden clappers. **Mülhausen, *Gutachten zu den Gottesdiensten in der Karwoche*, [1528]** (Reformed; Sehling 20/2, p. 207):

Likewise that the burial of the Lord in the sepulchre, with other uses, be put down; also that one knock not with the wooden boards, but ring to the offices with the bells as at other times. One might also well leave off the crucifix which is shown on that same day in the office, with some chants.

The same opinion stops the washing of the altars in Holy Week, unless a man wishes to wash his own altar (Sehling 20/2, p. 206).

Veiled, but removed all the same. At Regensburg a carved Coronation of Mary on the high altar had been kept covered, apparently as a compromise. It was nonetheless taken away and replaced by a painted panel of the "sum of the evangelical preaching". **Regensburg, *Kirchenordnung*, [1567]** (Sehling 13, p. 481):

Afterward the Coronation of Mary as Queen of Heaven on the high altar was likewise, although covered, nevertheless cleared away, and in its stead a painted panel set up upon the same altar, wherein the sum of the evangelical preaching of the Old and New Testament is to be seen.

Other Holy Week furnishings. The image plays of the church year went with the veils, as did the Easter sepulchre, the paschal candle and the blessings of the seasons. For the sepulchre and the Good Friday rite, see Chapter 13, §13.22.4. **Pfalz-Neuburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1543** (Sehling 13, p. 96):

On the other hand there shall be left off, first, all spectacles and plays which have been practised with images: as on Palm Sunday with the ass, on Good Friday with the crucifix and the sepulchre, on Easter Day with carrying about the image of the resurrection of Christ, on Ascension Day with drawing up the same, on Whitsunday with letting down the dove, on Christmas Day with rocking the little child, and all that hath been in use of the like kind everywhere or in some places heretofore. […] Neither shall

one any more hallow or bless holy water and salt, as was done every Sunday, nor wax at Candlemas [2 February], nor ashes on Ash Wednesday, nor palms on Palm Sunday, nor the paschal candle, nor the font, nor the fire on Easter Eve.

Hohenlohe 1553 repeats the list of image plays almost word for word (Sehling 15, p. 77).

Greenery and flowers. The orders treat seasonal greenery as folk custom, not as church furnishing. The Leiningen-Westerburg discipline order of 1566 forbids, among the "heathen" customs of Shrovetide and the year, setting up May branches, carrying banners and decking the church with flowers. **Leiningen-Westerburg, *Kirchenzuchtordnung*, 1566** (Sehling 19/1, p. 227):

Whereas nevertheless heathenish conduct is practised and kept, namely with begging for roasts, going about in masks, crying out the "fiefs", setting up May branches, burning the hail-tree, making St John's fires and leaping over them, and other godless fool's-work, carrying banners, decking the church with flowers, and ringing against the weather: so will we that such offensive and ungodly conduct and work be abolished.

The Palatine mandates of 1562 (Reformed) likewise forbid the young men and maids to set up May branches (Sehling 14, pp. 272–273). The one approving mention is at Hof. On the anniversary of the 1572 dedication of St Michael's, the neighbours strewed the lane with grass and set up "fine May branches" on both sides for the procession, "to the honour of God and his church" (Sehling 11, p. 467; see Chapter 13, §13.14.3).

Not found. No order mentions an Advent wreath, a Christmas tree, a crib set up in church (only the rocking of the Christ-child, abolished), or Easter flowers. The Advent wreath and the church Christmas tree belong to later centuries.

14.6.7 The paten, the host box and the bread dish

The searches. The corpus was searched for the paten (*Patene*, *Paten*, *patena*, *patina*, *pateen*; 140 passages once the many godparents, also *Paten*, were set aside). It was also searched for the vessels beside it: the box for the hosts (*Büchse*, *Lade*, *Schachtel*, *Kapsel*, *pyxis*, *ciborium*) and the Reformed dish or plate (*Schüssel*, *Teller*, *Platte*).

An ordinary vessel, kept. The Lutheran orders kept the paten as they kept the chalice, as a plain instrument of the Supper. Hannover (1536): "We use the customary vessels for the administration of the holy sacraments: chalice, paten, etc. For what Scripture doth not forbid, that we will not let be forbidden us" (Sehling 6/2, p. 1005). The paten was set out on the altar with the other things:

- **Regensburg (1542):** the epistoler "setteth the chalice, book, particles and paten on the altar" (Sehling 13, p. 391).
- **Regensburg (1567):** the priest and the *secundus* (second [minister]) carry chalice and paten out of the sacristy, and the *secundus* unwraps them and makes them ready on the altar (Sehling 13, p. 462).
- **Ritzebüttel (1556):** the priest stands at the altar in the customary Mass vestment, with "paten, chalice, bread and wine and burning wax lights" set on it (Sehling 5, p. 558).
- **Gottleuba (1567):** "in the office they use lighted candles on the altar, chalice, paten, Mass vestment and all other ornaments" (Sehling 1, p. 567).
- **Danzig (1557):** the sexton is to watch "so long as the book, the can, the chalice and the paten stand on the altar", that no harm or theft befall them (Sehling 4, p. 214).
- **Strasbourg (1598):** a box with the particles, a can of wine, the chalice and the paten are set on the altar at the beginning of the service (Sehling 20/1, p. 611).

In the hand at the Words of Institution. The commonest rubric puts the paten, with as many hosts as there are communicants, into the minister's hand while he says or sings the words over the bread. **Kurpfalz, *Gemaine maß*, 1546** (Sehling 14, p. 97):

And when he cometh to these words, "he took the bread", he taketh the paten, on which lie all the hosts, as many as there are communicants who have announced themselves beforehand, been absolved and admitted, into his hands; and when the words of consecration are finished, he layeth it away from him again. Likewise doth he afterwards also with the chalice.

The same rubric appears in many orders:

- **Livonia (1533):** the priest takes "the bread upon the paten into his hand", turns about over the altar toward the people, and speaks the words aloud (Sehling 5, p. 16).
- **Mecklenburg (1540/1545):** after the Lord's Prayer he "taketh the paten with the bread into his hand" and sings the Verba, turned toward the altar (Sehling 5, p. 154).

- **The *Cellische Ordnungen* (1545):** the priest lays "as many particles as belong to the communicants" in the paten, turns with it toward the people, and says the Verba in German (Sehling 1, p. 301).
- **Danzig (1557):** he takes "the paten with the appointed host into his hand without all papistical crossing and other gestures" (Sehling 4, p. 168).
- **Neuenrade (1564):** "he taketh the paten with the bread and turneth to the people" (Sehling 22, p. 519).
- **Schwarzburg (1574):** "he taketh the paten of the bread, wherein are as many particles as there are communicants" (Sehling 2, p. 133).
- **Henneberg (1582):** the minister shall "always have the paten with the particles in his hand" when he says "This is my body" (Sehling 2, p. 309).

The number of hosts on the paten was counted to the number of communicants. The Palatinate (Reformed) wants nothing left over to be reserved (above). Württemberg in 1562 found the minister in some places repeating the Verba "when there is no more bread and wine on the paten and in the chalice", and in others not (Sehling 16, p. 436).

Held under the chin. At the sick communion of Brandenburg (1540) "the priest shall also specially hold the paten cleanly under" as he gives the host (Sehling 3, p. 80). Pfalz-Neuburg (1543) adds "that nothing fall" (Sehling 13, p. 88). The Palatine sick order of 1556 dropped the instruction (editors' note, Sehling 14, p. 111). In the Mass the same office passed to the communion cloth held by two men or boys (§14.6.3).

Shown, and then not shown. The paten could be shown to the people with the chalice. Havelberg (1558) insists that the elevation of the sacrament remain, "much less shall the paten be elevated in the stead of the chalice" (Sehling 3, p. 230). Hohenlohe abolished the showing in 1596. **Hohenlohe, *Verbesserungen der Kirchenzeremonien*, 1596** (Sehling 15, p. 659):

So also concerning the showing of the paten and the chalice during the recitation of the words of the Supper, we also judge, since bread and wine in the action of the Supper are in any case set out openly on the altar, that therefore such showing of bread and wine (since our gracious lordship will have it so) shall be given up.

Nassau-Weilburg's explanations of 1617 likewise call it "unnecessary that the minister, while he speaketh the words of institution of the holy Supper, layeth hold of the paten and the chalice severally", and order it stopped (Sehling 10, p. 351). At Hof, before Pangratius's time, the deacon of the week broke his large host, "left a particle lying in the paten after the old catholic custom", and after communion dropped it into the chalice (Sehling 11, p. 453).

In the inventories. Patens were counted with the chalices:

- Potsdam (1541): "2 patens" beside five chalices; at the chapel of St Gertrude "the patens and vestments are burnt" (Sehling 3, pp. 259–260);
- Oschatz (1555): "8 chalices with their patens" (Sehling 1, p. 628);
- Fürstenberg in Mecklenburg (1578): "two silver gilt patens" (Sehling 5, p. 265; §14.6.6).

The Merseburg visitors of 1544 asked what the church had "in store in patens, monstrances, chalices and other silver" (Sehling 2, p. 12). Other orders charge the church officers with the patens and other treasures:

- the *Altermann* of Ermsleben (1564) hands over "the treasures of chalices, patens, albs, chasubles" to his successors (Sehling 2, p. 488);
- Pfalz-Neuburg (1576) orders the church doors and windows barred "with strong grilles and iron bolts" for the sake of the "chalices, patens and other" treasures (Sehling 13, p. 207);
- the Sponheim visitation order of 1590/91 lists, among the things each church must have, "a chalice and a paten for the communion; a capsule or box for the wafers or hosts; a pewter can, or where needful two, for the wine" (Sehling 18, p. 655).

The host box. The particles were kept in a box (*Lade*, *Schachtel*, *Kapsel*): Sponheim and Strasbourg (above; both Lutheran). The *ciborium* for reservation went with the monstrance: Pomerania 1535 needs no ciborium (Sehling 4, p. 342), and Teschen 1584 names "the shutting of the sacrament into the ciborium" among idolatrous ceremonies (Sehling 3, p. 461). Reservation is treated in §14.5.5.

The Reformed dish. The Reformed gave up the paten with the chalice:

- **Pfalz-Zweibrücken (1595, Reformed):** all chalices and patens were to be collected and made into beakers (§14.6.5).

- **Ysenburg-Birstein (1598, Reformed):** the ministers are not to use "consecrated chalices, patens and altars", but ordinary bread, broken and given into the hands, and "a clean drinking vessel" for the wine (Sehling 10, p. 645).
- **Wittgenstein (1605, Reformed):** the Mass vestments, patens and chalices are to be sold to advantage and a beaker bought for each place (Sehling 22, p. 149).
- **The dish.** In its place the bread was carried in a dish (*Schüssel*). Micron's London order (Reformed), printed with the Emden orders, passes the dishes with the bread among those sitting at the table (editors' comparison of the Supper forms, Sehling 7/1, p. 576). The Lutheran Marienhafe order of 1593 also names "table cloth, chalice, dish and can" for the Supper (Sehling 7/1, p. 710).

Not found. No order regulates the paten's material or size, or the veil and burse that go with it. None mentions the paten's use at the offertory, or the minister's wiping of it.

14.7 Vestments

14.7.1 The Mass vestment kept

Allstedt 1533. In Electoral Saxony the Lutheran visitors restored the Mass vestment where radicals had dropped it. At Allstedt, where Müntzer (Radical Reformation) had celebrated in a surplice or in ordinary clothes, pastors are to wear alb and chasuble "as is now done at Allstedt and also at Wittenberg", with two burning lights. These ceremonies serve good discipline and do no harm. **Allstedt, *Ordnung der Visitatoren*, 1533** (Sehling 1, p. 510):

Since also some until now have held Mass without albs and chasubles in a surplice, and some also in plain clothes, they shall henceforth also use albs and chasubles, as is now kept at Allstedt and also at Wittenberg and elsewhere, [and] have also two burning lights during Mass besides; for these ceremonies, which serve for the order of good discipline and are harmless …

Leisnig 1529. At Leisnig, where for six years the pastors had consecrated "without surplice and Mass vestment, simply in the coat", every pastor in the whole district is to use the Mass vestment whenever he consecrates, conforming to Torgau and Wittenberg. **Leisnig, *Verordnung der Visitatoren*, 1529** (Sehling 1, p. 605):

[whereas] the pastors and those who have reached the sacrament to the people have consecrated without surplice and Mass vestment, simply in the coat, it is earnestly commanded that henceforth all pastors, not only at Leisnig but in the whole district, use the Mass vestment and other harmless ceremonies as oft as they consecrate, and everywhere conform themselves to the booklet of the visitors and to the begun use of the churches at Torgau and Wittenberg.

Calenberg 1544/45. The Calenberg synods order the chasuble and two lights and abolish the elevation, for uniformity and "for the simple and weak's sake". **Calenberg-Göttingen, *Synodalkonstitutionen*, 1544/1545** (Sehling 6/2, p. 868):

[we] appoint therefore and ordain that the celebration of the Lord's Supper be held no otherwise than is set forth in the order; the elevation wholly abolished; the Mass vestments or chasuble put on; and two lights set upon the altar: not that anything special lieth on such ceremonies, but that we would gladly [have] a uniformity and seemliness for the simple and weak's sake.

Wolfenbüttel 1569. The Brunswick-Wolfenbüttel order requires the ministers, when there are communicants, to come to the altar "not only in their customary clothes" but in their church ornaments. **Brunswick-Wolfenbüttel, *Kirchenordnung*, 1569** (Sehling 6/1, p. 143):

pastors and ministers who will hold Mass, when communicants are present, [shall] step before the altar not merely in their customary clothes but in their church ornaments, as albs, chasubles and Mass vestment, finely and honestly and with great devotion and calling upon the Son of God, and begin, hold and perform the office of the Mass.

Grubenhagen 1544. Grubenhagen orders alb and chasuble and lights at the Sacrament, "to the honour of the sacrament", and the surplice for all other offices in church. **Grubenhagen, *Kirchenordnung*, 1544** (Sehling 6/2, p. 1032):

III. Of the clothing and lights which one shall use for the sacrament. And in such administering of the holy sacraments the pastors shall, to the honour of the sacrament, put on alb and chasuble and [have] lights burn upon the altar, and also sing the epistles and gospels in the German language with a customary accent; but outside the office in the church the pastor and the sexton shall have on and use their surplices.

Thorn 1575 has the priests minister "in the customary church clothes, chasuble and surplice" (§14.6.3), and Thüngen 1564 keeps the Mass vestment for peace (§14.3.3). Hildesheim 1544 keeps vestments and lights but leaves stole and maniple free (§14.3.3).

Riga 1530. The Riga order makes the variation itself a lesson in freedom: a plain surplice on Sundays, a cope or chasuble over it on high feasts, since there are still plenty of them, "that one may see that neither this nor that is needful". **Riga, *Kirchenordnung*, 1530** (Sehling 5, p. 17):

But on the feasts he may simply draw a cope or chasuble over the little surplice (since there are still enough of them, and otherwise, though they have cost much money, they spoil there), that by such constant change and alteration the freedom of such outward things may be the better perceived; that one may see that neither this nor that is needful, and that the freedom of the gospel is bound as little to black or blue coats as to surplices or copes or chasubles.

Kurland 1570. Kurland follows Riga: a white linen garment or surplice at the altar, any festal vestment allowed on high feasts, none in the pulpit. **Kurland, *Kirchenordnung*, 1570** (Sehling 5, p. 99):

therefore the priests, according to the old, laudable, remaining use of this church, shall serve the altar before the altar, when they hold the communion on Sunday or at other times, clad in a white linen garment or little surplice [...] But if on the aforesaid high feasts one will use before the altar, for a change, other silken vestments, chasubles, Mass vestment, priestly clothing and the like, it is also forbidden to no one. But in the pulpit one shall use no vesting, because it is unaccustomed in these lands according to the Riga church order.

14.7.2 The cope when there is no communion

Where there were no communicants, several orders forbade the chasuble, so that the people should not think the private Mass had returned. The minister wore a cope or a surplice instead. **Pfalz-Neuburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1543** (Sehling 13, p. 77):

then the priest shall step before the altar not in the customary Mass vestment, but in a cope or only in his surplice, and keep all things as is set above.

Brandenburg, *Kirchen-ordnung*, 1540 (Sehling 3, p. 71):

The priests also, when such offices are held, shall have on no chasuble, but only a cope, or in the villages, where there were no copes, a plain surplice; that the simple people abide not in, nor be led into, the former opinion, as though one would begin and hold again the Mass after the former manner, with the communion without communicants.

Schwäbisch Hall 1527. Brenz allows the deacon a cope at the common prayer, so that church vesture be not wholly rejected, but not a Mass vestment, "for it is neither a man's nor a woman's clothing". **Schwäbisch Hall, *Kirchenordnung*, 1527** (Sehling 17/1, p. 50):

And that church vesture be not wholly rejected, the deacon, if it would beseem him to show forth the earnestness and majesty of the prayer, might put on a cope, as hitherto was the custom at Vespers and Matins; but not a Mass vestment, for it is neither a man's nor a woman's clothing, but altogether too foolish to look upon before the common assembly.

14.7.3 Vestments abolished

Dalmatic and tunicle. The Homberg synod of 1526 (Moderate Reformed) forbids the vestments of deacons and subdeacons outright, since it will not favour orders without warrant in God's word. **Hesse, *Homberger Kirchenordnung*, 1526** (Moderate Reformed; Sehling 8, p. 46):

[24] Dalmatics, that is, the vestments of the papistical deacons or subdeacons, let no one put on henceforth. For we will not favour those orders without the testimonies of the oracles of God.

Regensburg 1554. The fullest statement of reasons in the corpus is Regensburg's, written by Nikolaus Gallus to be read from the pulpit, on why the "Levite and Mass vestments" are to go. First, both come from the Levitical priesthood and the papal Mass. **Regensburg, *Warum die leviten- und meßgewand sollen abgetan werden*, 29 April 1554** (Sehling 13, p. 432):

An honourable council together with us ministers of the word hath thought good that the Levite and Mass vestments at the communion in our Christian church here, as with many others, shall henceforth be wholly put away. The same for the following

causes: First, that both pieces (as the names in part still show) have come into our church from the Levitical priesthood of the Old Testament and from the pope's Mass, and have had their signification upon the Christ to come.

Second, the pope still requires them as necessary. Third, they hinder the simple and make it look as if there were little difference between the papal and the evangelical service. Anyone still offended after so many years of teaching "is hardly any more to be counted among the weak". The surplice stays, but only as a mark of the minister. **Regensburg, *Warum die leviten- und meßgewand sollen abgetan werden*, 29 April 1554** (Sehling 13, p. 433):

Yet we let the Levite and Mass vestments so fall, that we still for the time let the surplice remain, as we have kept it hitherto of free will, neither for the pope's nor for the Interim's sake, nor that it should be anything needful to the service of God, but only for a difference of the ministers, while they stand there in office, and the rest of the congregation.

The Regensburg order of [1567] repeats the reasons and adds the stole and the lights. **Regensburg, *Kirchenordnung*, [1567]** (Sehling 13, p. 480):

Accordingly we have also at last let fall the church vesture, as Mass vestment, stoles, Levite [vestments], etc., even as also the lights, which nevertheless from the beginning of the pure doctrine were kept a long time in our parish, together with some of the aforesaid feast days, for the causes that these things were brought without understanding out of the Old Testament, from the Levitical priesthood, which hath its end, into the New Testament, and turned into mere popish idolatry.

Transylvania 1557. The Hermannstadt synod holds that burning candles, *infulae* and ornaments, though indifferent in themselves, have ceased to be indifferent because so many churches have cast them out as popish dregs. They are to be laid aside in time, once the people are taught. A seemly white linen garment without images may serve instead. **Hermannstadt, *Synodalbeschlüsse*, 1557** (Sehling 24, p. 262):

The burning of candles, *infulae* and ornaments, even if they be indifferent things and of themselves neither profit nor hurt, yet since very many churches have cast them away as popish dregs, and they cannot now be retained without offence, and by this accident have ceased to be in the number of indifferent things, ought to be cast away in course of time, when the people shall have been taught that the true use of the sacrament consisteth not in that outward and shining show [...]. But since this sacred and most weighty action cannot be performed without some special seemliness, it may be done in a seemly white linen garment, void of images, as is manifest from the testimony of the primitive church.

Infula here most likely means the chasuble, as in other Transylvanian and Hungarian usage, not the mitre.

Others. The Sayn synod of 1575 drops the Mass vestment and keeps the surplice (Sehling 19/1, p. 356). Anhalt 1596 (Reformed) orders "Mass vestment and chasubles" laid aside (§14.5.2), and the Lutheran Sponheim 1590/91 turns them into altar cloths (§14.6.1).

14.7.4 The surplice

The minimum. Where nothing else survived, the surplice (*Chorrock*) usually did. It is the vestment most often named in the corpus, and the reasons given for it are always the same: to distinguish the minister in office from the congregation, and to keep the service seemly. Duke Albrecht's Prussian ordinance of 1543 forbids any pastor to preach, baptize or give the sacraments without at least a white surplice. **Prussia, *Befehl*, 1 February 1543** (Sehling 4, p. 60):

[shall] do no preaching, baptizing or reaching of sacraments, unless they have on at the least a white surplice, that so herein also outwardly a worldly difference may be seen between the minister of the word, when he is in his office, and another who is not called thereto.

Hesse 1532 (Moderate Reformed). The Hessian order uses the surplice "for the people's sake", to revive a reverence "almost wholly extinguished". **Hesse, *Ordenung der Christlichen kirchen*, 1532** (Moderate Reformed; Sehling 8, p. 76):

and, when it is assembled, it is thought fit for the people's sake (*that even so we may in some manner nourish the reverence of the common people, almost wholly extinguished*) to use a surplice.

Württemberg 1535. The preface to the Württemberg order of 1535 grants that clothing makes no man godly or ungodly, but rules the surplice in for all church offices. It is "not the least outward ornament of the church" that the minister be known by an

honest, distinct garment. Many weak believers had been put off the gospel by seeing ministers stand "in a stumpy little coat". **Württemberg, *Vorrede zur Kirchenordnung*, 1535** (Sehling 16, p. 133):

Of the clothing in the church office. Clothing of itself maketh neither godly nor ungodly, and is reckoned among the free things. […] so shall henceforth the surplice be used always in the church offices. For since all things in the church should go comely and in order, it is not the least outward ornament of the church that he who standeth before the common assembly of the church in the exercise of the church office be known by an honest, distinct garment. Moreover it is manifest that many weak in faith, for no other cause but this cause also, that they see the ministers standing in the offices without the hitherto customary church clothes, only in a stumpy little coat, have gotten a notable abhorrence of the preaching of the holy gospel and also of the use of the sacraments.

The great Württemberg order of 1553 confirms it "until our further decision". **Württemberg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1553** (Sehling 16, p. 266):

So may we suffer that the ministers in all offices which they are to perform in the church use the customary surplice until our further decision, and otherwise also in every way study an honest, seemly clothing, that not only their word and preaching but also their clothing, manner and bearing may be a teaching of virtue.

The Cellische Ordnungen 1545. The Albertine Saxon ordinances of 1545 make it a rule of clerical discipline. **Albertine Saxony, *Die Cellischen Ordnungen*, 1545** (Sehling 1, p. 302):

2. In the exercise of divine offices in the church the priests shall always have on a surplice, for in the church things shall go decently, comely and honestly.

Wittgenstein 1563. Wittgenstein leaves the old vestments free but keeps the surplice "with one accord", since a minister should be somewhat distinguished from others in his clothing. **Wittgenstein, *Kirchenordnung*, 1563** (Sehling 22, p. 97):

But since it is nevertheless meet and honest that a minister perform his office modestly before the congregation and be somewhat distinguished from others in his clothing, one shall keep and use the surplice thereto with one accord. And the pastors together with the churchwardens shall take order that the customary church ornaments be provided and kept clean.

Anhalt 1568. In Anhalt the surplice is worn at all three Sunday sermons and may be left off on weekdays. **Anhalt, *Abschied* of Prince Bernhard, 1568** (Sehling 2, p. 570):

likewise the surplice shall be used on Sunday at all three sermons, and over the week also be let go.

Limited. In Ernestine Saxony after 1554 the surplice was dropped in the pulpit but kept at the altar. **Ernestine Saxony, *Instruction* of the dukes, 1554** (Sehling 1, p. 224):

yet the use of the surplice in the pulpit shall be abolished in every way and in all places throughout, but at the altar during the reaching of the sacrament be permitted.

Coburg in the same year limits it to the communion, worn only by the one who celebrates. **Coburg, *Vorschaffung*, 1554** (Sehling 1, p. 544):

Sixthly, the surplice shall be used neither at burials nor in the pulpit nor otherwise in other church offices, but only at the communion, by the one person who holdeth the office.

Abolished. The Palatine Calvinists abolished the surplice with the communion cloth at Amberg in 1567 (Reformed), and the Lutheran Upper Palatine visitation of 1579 dropped both again under Ludwig VI (§14.6.3). The Sayn consistory did the same in 1582, in the same protocol that orders the remaining images removed (Sehling 19/1, p. 377).

The black gown. The Wild- und Rheingrafschaft order of 1603 is the only order found that prescribes a black gown. Each minister is to have a black church gown with sleeves made "at the first opportunity" and wear it in his office. White surplices are to be kept where they are in use, without superstition, and not abolished without the count's knowledge. **Wild- und Rheingrafschaft, *Kirchenordnung*, 1603** (Sehling 19/2, p. 630):

But especially we will that each of our ministers at the first opportunity get himself a black church gown with sleeves, and put it on in the performing of his office. But as for the white surplices, where the same are in practice and use in our churches, there shall one keep them without superstition or superstitious belief, and not abolish them without our knowledge.

14.7.5 What the orders do not mention

The orders never mention the amice, cincture, maniple (except to leave it free at Hildesheim), tunicle (except under "Levite vestments"), humeral veil, rochet, biretta, zucchetto, galero, pallium, rationale, episcopal gloves, tippet or hood, nor any preaching bands. No evangelical order provides a mitre or crosier, and none prescribes liturgical colours (§14.6.6). See §14.2.3.

14.8 Clerical dress outside the service

Long priestly coats. The orders want the minister to be recognisable in the street as well as in church. Grubenhagen 1544 adds to its rule on vestments (§14.7.1) that pastors are otherwise to go in long priestly coats. **Grubenhagen, *Kirchenordnung*, 1544** (Sehling 6/2, p. 1032):

Otherwise they shall go in seemly, honest, long priestly coats or clothing, and not stride along like soldiers and other wild young people.

The Albertine ordinances of 1545 give the same rule more fully. **Albertine Saxony, *Die Cellischen Ordnungen*, 1545** (Sehling 1, p. 302):

1. The priests shall wear honest long clothes, not so shortened and docked as the light-minded folk go about, nor wear slashed or coloured clothes, and in divine offices wear no cut-out shoes, which are offensive.

To be known. Regensburg [1567], which kept the surplice so that ministers in office might be known, adds that "outside the office also they should have their honest, priestly clothing for distinction's sake". **Regensburg, *Kirchenordnung*, [1567]** (Sehling 13, p. 481):

also for this cause, that the ministers, when they are in their office, may be the more known in and before the rest of the congregation, as they should also otherwise, outside the office, have their honest, priestly clothing for distinction's sake.

The Wild- und Rheingrafschaft order of 1603, which introduced the black gown (§14.7.4), says the same. **Wild- und Rheingrafschaft, *Kirchenordnung*, 1603** (Sehling 19/2, p. 630):

For although clothing in the church, and also outside it, maketh no man either holier or unholier, yet because all things should go honestly and comely, therefore we will that our ministers, in and outside their office, so bear themselves in clothing that nothing be taken from the dignity of the ministry and of the minister, so far as is possible.

Württemberg 1553 asks the same "honest, seemly clothing", so that the ministers' dress, manner and bearing may be "a teaching of virtue" (§14.7.4). Riga 1530 reminds them that the gospel is not bound to "black or blue coats" any more than to surplices (§14.7.1).

Related. Freiberg 1537 abolishes "wearing tonsures [and] cowls" among the merely human ordinances, and Brunswick 1528 wants no tonsure and no special coat for deacons (see Chapter 16, §16.3.3).

The conduct required of ministers and their households is treated in Chapter 15, §15.3.3.

14.9 Table by order

Key.

- The orders are listed by date.
- "—" means that nothing on the point was found in the passages examined. It does not mean that the order forbids it.
- Each cell reports only what the order itself says. The § column gives the sections of this chapter where the evidence is quoted or cited.

Order	Vol.	Images and crucifix	Altar, lights, font, building	Paraments and vessels	Vestments	§
Wittenberg, *Kirchen-Ordnung*, 1522	1	Images removed	Three altars without images	—	—	14.5.1

Order	Vol.	Images and crucifix	Altar, lights, font, building	Paraments and vessels	Vestments	§
			enough			
Strasbourg, mandate, 1525 (Moderate Reformed)	20/1	No removal of images, altars, panels without the council	—	—	—	14.4.2
Pomesania, *Themata*, 1525	4	Not to be prayed to; no lights before them	—	—	—	14.4.1
Prussia, *Artikel der ceremonien*, 1525	4	—	Customary font kept	—	—	14.5.6
Luther, *Deutsche Messe*, 1526	1	No covering of images, hunger cloth or palm-shooting in Holy Week	—	—	—	14.4.1, 14.6.6
Hesse, Homberg synod, 1526 (Moderate Reformed)	8	—	Candles commended; no reservation in ambries; no Candlemas blessing of candles	No new paraments, chasubles or copes; chasuble free; seemly chalice	Surplice at least; dalmatics and tunicles forbidden	14.3.3, 14.5.4, 14.5.5, 14.6.4, 14.7.3
Schwäbisch Hall (Brenz), 1527	17/1	—	—	—	Deacon may wear a cope at prayer, never a Mass vestment	14.7.2
Brunswick (Bugenhagen), 1528	6/1	Only worshipped images removed by authority; histories stay	—	Lights and banners at baptism needless	—	14.4.1, 14.4.6
Mülhausen, Holy Week opinion, [1528] (Reformed)	20/2	Good Friday crucifix showing dropped	Sepulchre, clappers and altar washing dropped	—	—	14.6.6
Schmiedeberg, visitation, 1528	1	—	—	Two chalices and three best vestments kept; albs to the hospital; rest sold	—	14.6.4
Breslau, *Schul- und Kirchenordnung*, 1528	3	—	—	Black funeral cloths for a fee	—	14.6.6

Order	Vol.	Images and crucifix	Altar, lights, font, building	Paraments and vessels	Vestments	§
Colditz, visitation, 1529	1	—	Altars arranged for the minister to face the people	—	—	14.5.2
Leisnig, visitation, 1529	1	—	—	—	Mass vestment restored whenever consecrating	14.7.1
Riga, *Kirchenordnung*, 1530	5	—	—	—	Surplice on Sundays; cope or chasuble on feasts, to show freedom	14.7.1
Ulm, *Kirchenordnung*, 1531 (Moderate Reformed)	17/2	Worshipped images removed by officials	—	—	—	14.4.4
Hesse, *Ordenung*, 1532 (Moderate Reformed)	8	—	—	—	Surplice for the people's reverence	14.7.4
Brandenburg-Nürnberg, 1533	11	—	Lights free	Altar covering and vessels free	Mass vestment free	14.3.1
Allstedt, visitation, 1533	1	—	Before, not behind, the altar; two lights	—	Alb and chasuble restored	14.5.2, 14.5.4, 14.7.1
Wittenberg, *Kirchen-Ordnung*, 1533	1	—	Schoolboys in the north gallery	—	—	14.5.7
Bremen, *Kirchenordnung*, 1534	7/2.2	—	Warm water in the font basin in winter	—	—	14.5.6
Württemberg, preface, 1535	16	—	—	—	Surplice in all offices, as church ornament and for the weak	14.7.4
Hannover, *Kirchenordnung*, 1536	6/2	Crucifix and honest images kept	Lights on the altar; font; altar	Customary vessels	Customary priestly clothing at the altar	14.3.1
Württemberg, *Kastenordnung*, 1536	16	—	Endowments for the eternal light to the common chest	—	—	14.5.4
Württemberg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1536	16	—	Choose the most convenient altar	—	—	14.5.1

Order	Vol.	Images and crucifix	Altar, lights, font, building	Paraments and vessels	Vestments	§
Strasbourg, *Agende*, 1537 (Moderate Reformed)	20/1	—	Altar-table set up facing the people	—	—	14.5.2
Freiberg, visitation, 1538	1	Crucifix carried before every funeral	—	—	—	14.4.5
Brandenburg, *Kirchen-ordnung*, 1540	3	—	Blessing of lights and herbs dropped	Sick chalice, corporal, pall	Cope or surplice, no chasuble, without communicants	14.5.4, 14.6.2, 14.7.2
Neumark, *Kasten-Ordnung*, 1540	3	—	Each guild to keep a window and give wax for winter lights	—	—	14.5.4, 14.5.7
Salza, *Kirchen-Ordnung für Salza*, 1540	1	Banners and idolatrous images removed	All altars but one; screens removed	—	—	14.4.6, 14.5.1, 14.5.7
Schönburg, *Kirchen-Ordnung*, 1542	2	—	No sacrament or lamps in the sacrament house	—	—	14.5.5
Prussia, *Befehl*, 1543	4	—	—	—	No preaching or sacraments without at least a white surplice	14.7.4
Pfalz-Neuburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1543	13	Image plays of the feasts abolished	No blessing of Candlemas wax, paschal candle or Easter fire; Holy Week Matins without din	—	Cope or surplice, no Mass vestment, without communicants	14.5.4, 14.6.6, 14.7.2
Schweinfurt, *Kirchenordnung*, 1543	11	Luther's view; uncertain histories removed by authority	Lights left; Candlemas sermon against the lights	—	—	14.4.1, 14.5.4
Grubenhagen, *Kirchenordnung*, 1544	6/2	Crucifix in mid-church and panels over altars kept; all else removed	Side altars, candlesticks, banners, screens removed	—	Alb, chasuble, lights at the Sacrament; surplice otherwise; long coats	14.4.2, 14.7.1, 14.8
Hildesheim, *Kerckenordeninge*, 1544	7/2.1	—	Lights explained by the night of the Supper	—	Vestments kept until all agree; stole and maniple free	14.3.3, 14.5.4

Order	Vol.	Images and crucifix	Altar, lights, font, building	Paraments and vessels	Vestments	§
Nördlingen (Löner), 1544	12	—	Font railed and adorned	—	—	14.5.6
Calenberg-Göttingen synods, 1544/45	6/2	—	Two lights; elevation abolished	—	Chasuble	14.7.1
Albertine Saxony, *Cellische Ordnungen*, 1545	1	—	—	—	Surplice always in church; long clothes, no slashed or coloured	14.7.4, 14.8
Nuremberg, Dietrich's *Agendbüchlein*, 1545	11	Crucifix at the deathbed not evil; the word the best crucifix	—	—	—	14.4.5
Wittenbergische Reformation, 1545	1	—	Against standing behind the table	—	—	14.5.2
Kurpfalz, *Gemaine maß*, 1546	14	—	One lamp only	Paten with the hosts taken in hand at the Verba	—	14.5.4, 14.6.7
Ansbach, *Auctuarium*, 1548 (Interim order)	11	—	Altar candles lit throughout Mass and Vespers	—	—	14.5.4
Mecklenburg, visitation, 1552	5	Images nailed to the walls; banners and crosses removed	All altars but the high altar; ciboria removed	—	—	14.4.2, 14.4.6, 14.5.1
Hohenlohe, *Kirchenordnung*, 1553	15	Image plays abolished	No reservation	Silk cloth held by two men; kneeling benches	—	14.4.6, 14.5.5, 14.6.3, 14.6.6
Regensburg (Jonas), 1553	13	—	—	Deacons in surplices hold the cloth	—	14.6.3
Württemberg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1553	16	—	—	—	Surplice until further notice; honest dress	14.7.4, 14.8
Coburg, *Vorschaffung*, 1554	1	—	—	—	Surplice only at communion	14.7.4
Ernestine Saxony, *Instruction*, 1554	1	—	—	—	Surplice not in the pulpit, kept at the altar	14.7.4

Order	Vol.	Images and crucifix	Altar, lights, font, building	Paraments and vessels	Vestments	§
Regensburg, reasons, 1554	13	—	—	—	Levite and Mass vestments abolished; surplice kept	14.7.3
Gotha, visitation, 1555	1	Non-biblical images not suffered	Altars arranged for facing the people	—	—	14.4.1, 14.5.2
Lüneburg, *Reformatio coenobiorum*, 1555	6/1	—	No blessing of palms, Easter candles, water or fire	—	—	14.5.4
Henneberg, Römhild, 1556	2	—	—	Covers for altar, pulpit, font from old vestments; pall	—	14.6.1
Upper Palatinate, instruction, 1557	13	Removed by night; carved taken out, painted blacked over	All altars but one	—	—	14.4.2, 14.5.1
Speyer, *Kirchenordnung*, 1557	19/1	—	—	Two boys hold the cloths	—	14.6.3
Hermannstadt, synod, 1557	24	Fabulous images removed; sacred histories kept	Candles to be laid aside	—	*Infulae* and ornaments laid aside; white linen garment	14.4.2, 14.7.3
Pfalz-Zweibrücken, visitation, 1558	18	—	Nuns' choir screen torn away	—	—	14.5.7
Pfalz-Neuburg, visitation, 1560	13	—	Sacrament houses and unused altars removed	—	—	14.5.5
Anhalt, *Kirchenordnung auf dem Lande*, 1562	2	Crucifix kept in honour	Altar and font kept clean	White linen or tapestries	Mass vestment kept	14.4.5, 14.6.1
Suhl, *Ordnung des predigamts*, 1562	2	—	Sunday service with communion held without lights	—	—	14.5.4
Kurpfalz, mandates, 1562 (Reformed)	14	—	Young people not to set up May branches	—	—	14.6.6
Heidelberg Catechism, 1563 (Reformed)	14	Images not to be suffered as laity's books	—	—	—	14.4.4

Order	Vol.	Images and crucifix	Altar, lights, font, building	Paraments and vessels	Vestments	§
Wittgenstein, *Kirchenordnung*, 1563	22	—	—	Ornaments kept clean	Old vestments free; surplice kept	14.7.4
Lüneburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1564	6/1	—	Fonts before the choir, raised a step or two	—	—	14.5.6
Thüngen, *Kirchenordnung*, 1564	11	Idols removed; scriptural histories kept as laity's Bible	Candles kept for peace	—	Mass vestment kept for peace	14.3.3, 14.4.1
Hermannstadt, synod, 1565	24	—	Altars not to be pulled down; restored	—	—	14.5.1
Leiningen-Westerburg, *Kirchenzuchtordnung*, 1566	19/1	Banners not to be carried	May branches and decking the church with flowers forbidden	—	—	14.6.6
Kurpfalz, *Befehl*, 1565 (Reformed)	14	Altars, crucifixes, Mounts of Olives removed	Sacrament houses, fonts, stoups removed	—	—	14.4.4
Amberg, mandate, 1567 (Reformed)	13	—	—	Communion cloth abolished	—	14.6.3
Regensburg, *Kirchenordnung*, [1567]	13	Middle way: histories kept, lying images removed; covered Coronation of Mary removed	Lights dropped	—	Mass vestment and stole dropped; surplice kept; priestly dress outside	14.4.1, 14.6.6, 14.7.3, 14.8
Prussia, *KO und Ceremonien*, 1568	4	Against Calvinist image-storming	—	—	—	14.4.4
Anhalt, Prince Bernhard, 1568	2	—	—	—	Surplice at all Sunday sermons	14.7.4
Wolfenbüttel, *Kirchenordnung*, 1569	6/1	—	Clean cloths and lights on the altar	—	Albs and chasubles with communicants	14.5.4, 14.7.1
Kurland, *Kirchenordnung*, 1570	5	New paintings of resurrection and Judgement	One altar; two candles and a pulpit light; fine font	Two chalices; font towels and cloths	White linen or surplice; festal vestments free; none in the pulpit	14.4.3, 14.5.1, 14.5.4, 14.5.6, 14.6.5, 14.7.1

Order	Vol.	Images and crucifix	Altar, lights, font, building	Paraments and vessels	Vestments	§
Hadersleben, pew mandate, 1571	23	—	Pews rebuilt to clear the aisle	—	—	14.5.7
Oldenburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1573	7/2.1	Scriptural histories kept with profit	—	—	—	14.4.1
Wolfstein, Stieber's *Instructio*, 1574	13	Crucifix before funerals allowed	—	—	—	14.4.5
Sayn, synod, 1575	19/1	—	—	—	Mass vestment dropped; surplice kept	14.7.3
Thorn, *Kirchenordnung*, 1575	4	—	—	Boys hold silk cloths	Chasuble and surplice	14.6.3, 14.7.1
Nassau-Weilburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1576	10	—	Sacrament houses and ossuaries removed	—	—	14.5.5
Mecklenburg, visitation of Fürstenberg, 1578	5	—	Two brass candlesticks on the altar	Silver-gilt chalices and patens; linen for the altar	Red-and-green and red velvet chasubles; red damask deacon's coats	14.6.6
Lichtenberg, instruction, 1579	18	Images and crucifixes removed	—	—	—	14.4.4
Salzwedel, visitation, 1579	3	—	Guilds to repair their windows	—	—	14.5.7
Upper Palatinate, visitation, 1579	13	—	—	Communion cloth dropped	Surplice dropped	14.6.3
Saxony, *Ordnung*, 1580	1	—	No pews without leave; mischief on galleries	—	—	14.5.7
Siegen, mandate, 1581 (Reformed)	10	Images and panels removed	Altars and organs removed; table	Beaker for chalice	—	14.5.3, 14.6.5
Marggrabowa and Sensburg, *Gottesdienstordnungen*, 1581	4	—	Altar lights lit when there are communicants	—	Mass vestment with communicants; surplice otherwise	14.5.4
Sayn, consistory, 1582	19/1	Remaining images removed	—	—	Surplice abolished	14.7.4
Magdeburg, *Instruktion*, 1583	2	Worshipped images removed	Sacrament houses removed; lights as	Altar cloths as each church has them	Mass vestment and surplice as	14.3.2

Order	Vol.	Images and crucifix	Altar, lights, font, building	Paraments and vessels	Vestments	§
			each church has them		each church has them	
Mansfeld, consistorial order, 1586	2	Crucifix and Bible on the oath table	Two candles	Black pall with white cross	—	14.4.5
Kurpfalz, Casimirian mandate, 1587 (Reformed)	19/2	—	Wooden tables for altars; no font	One chalice kept, silver beakers	—	14.5.3, 14.6.5
Gottorf, *Visitationsartikel*, 1587	23	—	Visitors ask whether candles are lit or removed	—	Linen and silk vestments: in use or abolished?	14.5.4
Bentheim-Tecklenburg, 1588 (Reformed)	22	—	Fonts moved out of the corners	—	—	14.5.6
Hintere Grafschaft Sponheim, 1590/91 and 1607	18	Crucifix and images removed	Old fonts and altars to be cleared out	Surplices and vestments made into altar cloths	—	14.4.4, 14.5.6, 14.6.1
Hof, *Ordo ecclesiasticus*, 1592	11	—	Grass and May branches for the dedication procession	—	—	14.6.6
Marienhafe, *Kirchenordnung*, 1593	7/1	—	"Altar or table"	Table-cloth, chalice, dish and can	—	14.5.3
Pfalz-Zweibrücken, mandate, 1595 (Reformed)	18	—	—	Chalices and patens melted for beakers	—	14.6.5
Hohenlohe, *Verbesserungen der Kirchenzeremonien*, 1596	15	—	—	Showing of paten and chalice at the Verba stopped	—	14.6.7
Sorau, *Kirchenordnung*, 1595 (extract)	3	—	—	Boys hold the communion cloths	Boys in red smocks with green garlands	14.6.6
Anhalt, Johann Georg, 1596 (Reformed)	2	Panels and carved crucifixes removed	Behind the table; lights laid aside; table for altar	—	Mass vestment and chasubles laid aside	14.5.2, 14.7.3
Simmern, mandate, 1598 (Reformed)	19/2	Idol-work removed	Altars and fonts abolished; tables	—	—	14.5.3
Wild- und Rheingrafschaft, 1603	19/2	—	—	—	Black gown with sleeves; white surplices kept where used	14.7.4, 14.8

Order	Vol.	Images and crucifix	Altar, lights, font, building	Paraments and vessels	Vestments	§
Leiningen-Hardenburg, visitation, 1609	19/1	—	—	Altar, font, pulpit and desk to be covered	—	14.6.1
Nassau-Weilburg, *Erläuterungspunkte*, 1617	10	No crucifix before corpses	—	Communion cloth abolished	—	14.4.5, 14.6.3

14.10 Concordance of the orders quoted

The concordance. Every order quoted in this chapter is listed below, with the volume and pages of Sehling and the sections where it is quoted. Orders cited only in summary can be found through the table in §14.9 and the text.

Order	Title	Date	Sehling	Quoted in §
Albertine Saxony	*Die Cellischen Ordnungen*	1545	1, p. 302	14.7.4, 14.8
Allstedt	*Ordnung der Visitatoren*	1533	1, p. 510	14.7.1
Anhalt	*Abschied* of Prince Bernhard	1568	2, p. 570	14.7.4
Anhalt	*Kirchenordnung auf dem Lande*	22 July 1562	2, p. 562	14.4.5
Anhalt (Reformed)	*Verordnung Johann Georgs*	3 November 1596	2, p. 580	14.5.2
Bentheim-Tecklenburg (Reformed)	*Kirchenordnung*	1588	22, p. 268	14.5.6
Brandenburg	*Kirchen-ordnung*	1540	3, pp. 71, 80	14.6.2, 14.7.2
Brandenburg-Nürnberg	*Kirchenordnung*	1533	11, p. 183	14.3.1
Bremen	*Kirchenordnung*	1534	7/2.2, p. 439	14.5.6
Brunswick	*Kirchenordnung*	1528	6/1, p. 445	14.4.1
Brunswick-Wolfenbüttel	*Kirchenordnung*	1569	6/1, p. 143	14.5.4, 14.7.1
Calenberg-Göttingen	*Synodalkonstitutionen*	1544/1545	6/2, p. 868	14.7.1
Coburg	*Vorschaffung*	1554	1, p. 544	14.7.4
Colditz	*Verordnung der Visitatoren*	1529	1, p. 545	14.5.2
Ernestine Saxony	*Instruction* of the dukes	1554	1, p. 224	14.7.4
Freiberg	*Visitation Verordnung und Artikel*	1538	1, p. 468	14.4.5
Gotha	*Artikel der Visitatoren*	1555	1, p. 569	14.5.2
Gottorf	*Visitationsartikel*	1587	23, p. 371	14.5.4
Grubenhagen	*Kirchenordnung*	1544	6/2, pp. 1032, 1034	14.4.2, 14.7.1, 14.8
Hadersleben	*Mandat zu den Kirchenstühlen*	31 May 1571	23, p. 242	14.5.7
Hannover	*Kirchenordnung*	1536	6/2, p. 1009	14.3.1

Order	Title	Date	Sehling	Quoted in §
Henneberg	*Abschied der Visitatoren für die Superintendenz zu Römhild*	20 December 1556	2, p. 328	14.6.1
Hermannstadt	*Synodalbeschlüsse*	1557	24, p. 262	14.4.2, 14.7.3
Hermannstadt	*Synodalartikel*	1565	24, p. 293	14.5.1
Hesse (Moderate Reformed)	*Homberger Kirchenordnung*	1526	8, pp. 45, 46, 49	14.3.3, 14.5.4, 14.5.5, 14.6.4, 14.7.3
Hesse (Moderate Reformed)	*Ordenung der Christlichen kirchen*	1532	8, p. 76	14.7.4
Hildesheim	*Christlike kerckenordeninge*	1544	7/2.1, p. 852	14.3.3, 14.5.4
Hintere Grafschaft Sponheim	*Kirchen- und Zensurordnung*	1590/91	18, p. 653	14.6.1
Hohenlohe	*Kirchenordnung*	1553	15, p. 71	14.6.3
Hohenlohe	*Verbesserungen der Kirchenzeremonien*	1596	15, p. 659	14.6.7
Kurland	*Kirchenordnung*	1570	5, pp. 87, 98, 99	14.4.3, 14.5.4, 14.7.1
Kurpfalz	*Gemaine maß, die kirchen- und gottesdinst anzurichten*	1546	14, pp. 94, 97	14.5.4, 14.6.7
Kurpfalz (Reformed)	*Heidelberger Katechismus*, Question 98, *Kirchenordnung*	1563	14, p. 362	14.4.4
Kurpfalz (Reformed)	*Casimirianische Kirchenordnung*, mandate	1587	19/2, p. 757	14.5.3
Kurpfalz (Reformed)	*Amberger Mandat*	20 January 1567	13, p. 303	14.6.3
Kurpfalz (Reformed)	*Befehl an die Amtleute*	3 October 1565	14, p. 429	14.4.4
Leiningen-Hardenburg	*Visitations- und Täuferordnung*	1609	19/1, p. 315	14.6.1
Leiningen-Westerburg	*Kirchenzuchtordnung*	1566	19/1, p. 227	14.6.6
Leisnig	*Verordnung der Visitatoren*	1529	1, p. 605	14.7.1
Lichtenberg	*Dienstanweisung für die Pfarrer*	1579	18, p. 379	14.4.4
Lüneburg	*Reformatio coenobiorum*	1555	6/1, p. 615	14.5.4
Lüneburg	*Kirchenordnung*	1564	6/1, p. 554	14.5.6
Magdeburg	*Instruktion zur Visitation*	25 May 1583	2, p. 424	14.3.2
Mansfeld	*Form und weise … mit den öffentlichen eidesleistungen*, appended to the consistorial order	1586	2, p. 214	14.4.5
Marggrabowa	*Gottesdienstordnung*	1581	4, p. 149	14.5.4
Marienhafe	*Kirchenordnung*	1593	7/1, p. 710	14.5.3

Order	Title	Date	Sehling	Quoted in §
Mecklenburg	*Visitations-Instruction*	12 November 1552	5, p. 220	14.4.2
Mecklenburg	*Ordnung der Visitatoren für Fürstenberg*	1578	5, p. 265	14.6.6
Mülhausen (Reformed)	*Gutachten zu den Gottesdiensten in der Karwoche*	[1528]	20/2, p. 207	14.6.6
Nassau-Weilburg	*Kirchenordnung*	1576	10, p. 310	14.5.5
Nassau-Weilburg	*Erläuterungspunkte zur Kirchenordnung*	1617	10, pp. 351, 353	14.4.5, 14.6.3
Neumark	*Kasten-Ordnung*	1 March 1540	3, p. 32	14.5.4, 14.5.7
Nuremberg	*Agendbüchlein Veit Dietrichs*	1545	11, p. 522	14.4.5
Nördlingen	*Kirchenordnung Kaspar Löners*	1544	12, p. 314	14.5.6
Oldenburg	*Kirchenordnung*	1573	7/2.1, p. 1083	14.4.1
Pfalz-Neuburg	*Kirchenordnung*	1543	13, pp. 77, 96	14.6.6, 14.7.2
Pfalz-Neuburg	*Visitationsordnung*	1560	13, p. 135	14.5.5
Pfalz-Zweibrücken	*Visitationsordnung*	1558	18, p. 270	14.5.7
Pfalz-Zweibrücken (Reformed)	*Mandat zur Ablieferung der Vasa sacra*	7 April 1595	18, p. 410	14.6.5
Pomesania	*Themata episcopi Risenburgensis*	1525	4, p. 29	14.4.1
Prussia	*Artikel der ceremonien und anderer kirchen ordnung*	10 December 1525	4, p. 33	14.5.6
Prussia	*Befehl* (command)	1 February 1543	4, p. 60	14.7.4
Prussia	*Kirchenordnung und Ceremonien*	1568	4, p. 73	14.4.4
Regensburg	*Kirchenordnung unter Justus Jonas*	1553	13, p. 421	14.6.3
Regensburg	*Kirchenordnung*	[1567]	13, pp. 480, 481	14.4.1, 14.6.6, 14.7.3, 14.8
Regensburg	*Warum die leviten- und meßgewand sollen abgetan werden*	29 April 1554	13, pp. 432, 433	14.7.3
Riga	*Kirchenordnung*	1530	5, p. 17	14.7.1
Saxony	*Ordnung Herzog Augusts*	1580	1, p. 451	14.5.7
Schmiedeberg	*Verordnung der Visitatoren*	1528	1, p. 664	14.6.4
Schwäbisch Hall	*Kirchenordnung*	1527	17/1, p. 50	14.7.2
Schönburg	*Kirchen-Ordnung* of Johann Pfeffinger	18 October 1542	2, p. 175	14.5.5
Simmern (Reformed)	*Mandat zur Abschaffung der Bilder und Altäre*	2 October 1598	19/2, p. 661	14.5.3
Sorau	*Kirchenordnung*, extract after J. S. Magnus	1595	3, p. 372	14.6.6

Order	Title	Date	Sehling	Quoted in §
Speyer	*Kirchenordnung*	1557	19/1, p. 92	14.6.3
Strasbourg (Moderate Reformed)	*Agende*	1537	20/1, p. 270	14.5.2
Strasbourg (Moderate Reformed)	*Mandat über Bilder und Altäre*	18 March 1525	20/1, p. 166	14.4.2
Suhl	*Ordnung des predigamts und lektionen*	1562	2, p. 351	14.5.4
Thorn	*Kirchenordnung*	1575	4, p. 237	14.6.3
Thüngen	*Kirchenordnung*	1564	11, pp. 736–737, 739	14.3.3, 14.4.1
Ulm (Moderate Reformed)	*Kirchenordnung*	1531	17/2, p. 145	14.4.4
Upper Palatinate	*Visitationsinstruktion*	1557	13, p. 297	14.4.2
Upper Palatinate	*Visitationsordnung*	1579	13, p. 315	14.6.3
Wild- und Rheingrafschaft	*Kirchenordnung*	1603	19/2, p. 630	14.7.4, 14.8
Wittenberg	*Kirchen-Ordnung*	1522	1, p. 697	14.5.1
Wittenberg	*Kirchen-Ordnung*	1533	1, p. 704	14.5.7
Wittgenstein	*Kirchenordnung*	1563	22, p. 97	14.7.4
Wolfstein	*Christliche Instructio des Thomas Stieber*	1574	13, p. 586	14.4.5
Württemberg	*Vorrede zur Kirchenordnung*	1535	16, p. 133	14.7.4
Württemberg	*Kirchenordnung*	1536	16, p. 107	14.5.1
Württemberg	*Kastenordnung*	1536	16, p. 96	14.5.4
Württemberg	*Kirchenordnung*	1553	16, p. 266	14.7.4

Chapter 15. Ecclesiastical Duties

This chapter sets out what the evangelical church orders of the sixteenth century, printed in Emil Sehling's *Die evangelischen Kirchenordnungen des XVI. Jahrhunderts*, required of each estate in the church. It asks:

- **Clergy.** What were pastors and deacons, superintendents, members and presidents of consistories, and professors of theology expected or required to do?
- **Training.** How were ministers trained: school, university and stipend, practice preaching, examination, a probationary period, and continuing study after ordination?
- **Laity.** What did the orders require of ordinary church members: attendance, prayer at home, confession and communion? Were sextons, schoolmasters and other church workers held to a higher standard?
- **Schoolmasters.** What were their church duties?
- **The magistrate.** What were the prince's and the council's duties towards the church?
- **Catechesis.** How often was the catechism taught, and for how long? What did it require? Was first communion separate from confirmation, and did each require instruction? Did any order give communion to infants? Was there catechesis or counselling before marriage?

How the chapter is laid out.

- §15.1 answers each question in brief, and §15.2 sets out the scope, the sources and the negative findings.
- §§15.3–15.6 cover the clergy:
  - §15.3, pastors and deacons;
  - §15.4, superintendents and deans;
  - §15.5, consistories, their presidents and members;
  - §15.6, professors of theology.
- §15.7 covers the training of ministers.
- §15.8 covers the laity and the church workers.
- §15.9 covers schoolmasters, and §15.10 the magistrate.
- §15.11 covers catechesis, where all the estates meet: its frequency and length, first communion, confirmation, instruction before marriage, and infant communion.
- §15.12 is a table by order, and §15.13 a concordance of every order quoted.

Related chapters. Several subjects are treated more fully elsewhere and are only cited here:

- preaching and the catechism sermon: Chapter 11;
- the daily office and the obligations of clergy and students to it: Chapter 10, §10.6;
- confirmation, marriage, ordination, installation, sextons, schoolmasters and magistrates as rites: Chapter 13, §§13.6, 13.7, 13.10–13.13;
- deacons, elders and the minor offices: Chapter 16;
- the oaths and confessional subscriptions of ministers: Chapter 17;
- clerical dress: Chapter 14, §14.8;
- the catechism service, its hour, length and order: Chapter 10, §10.10;
- private confession and the examination of communicants: Chapter 13, §13.17;
- the hearers during the sermon: Chapter 11, §11.12.

15.1 Summary of findings

1. Pastors: preach, administer, catechize, visit, study, and live as an example (§15.3). The visitation questions sum up the office: preaching, the sacraments, the catechism, weddings, and visiting the sick and sorrowful (Strasbourg 1598). The pastor's other duties:

- **study** a set list of books: the Bible, Luther's postil, Melanchthon's *Loci* (Commonplaces) and the Augsburg Confession, with copies bought for every parish (Saxony 1557; Hoya 1581);
- **marry**, keep out of taverns and trade, and bring up wife, children and servants as a model household, which the visitors inspected;
- **reside**, never leaving the parish overnight without leave and a substitute (Hoya 1581);

- **keep registers** of baptisms, marriages and burials from mid-century (Saxony 1580).

The deacons had the catechism and the sick as their particular charges, "readier to serve the poor herein than the rich" (Saxony 1555).

2. Superintendents: visit, hold synod, examine, report (§15.4). The Saxon pattern of 1555–1557 gives the superintendent four tasks:

- to watch over the doctrine, life and diligence of the pastors;
- to visit unannounced, hearing sermons and examining the youth;
- to hold a synod every year between Easter and Whitsun;
- to examine and install new pastors, and send to the consistory what he cannot mend.

By 1600 the superintendent was sworn to the confessional corpus and acted as the consistory's agent (Grubenhagen). In Transylvania the chapters elected their own deans (Lasseln 1572).

3. Consistories: theologians and jurists; the president disputed (§15.5). The consistory judged marriage cases, church discipline "so far as the degrees of admonition" go, the affairs of ministers, and church property (Saxony 1580). The orders differed over who should preside:

- the prince in person (Weimar 1561);
- the superintendent (Jena 1569);
- a nobleman (Dresden 1580);
- a lay councillor, so that the clergy should not seem to "lay hold on the worldly sword … like the Pope" (Regensburg 1588).

The consistories met weekly and were sworn to secrecy.

4. Professors: no seminaries (§15.6). No order founds a seminary. Professors of theology appear in the orders as members of consistories, as examiners and ordainers (Wittenberg, Leipzig, Marburg, Helmstedt), as overseers of the stipendiaries, and as public lecturers.

5. Training: stipend, practice sermon, examination, probation, synod (§15.7). There was no vicarage year, but training had parts that did similar work:

- stipends for poor students, bound to serve the territory;
- the Tübingen *Stipendium* (1559), where masters preached in the house and were corrected "in invention, disposition or delivery" the same day;
- practice sermons in the parish with the pastor's leave (Saxony 1555);
- examination and a trial sermon before ordination, and if needed some weeks of instruction at Wittenberg or Marburg;
- a probation as deacon before a parish, with a re-examination (Palatinate 1564, Reformed), and the new deacons' sermon outlines sent in for criticism after a year (Palatinate 1607, Reformed).

After ordination the synods set reading "that the priests may be moved the more diligently to read and the sooner to buy books" (Nassau 1552). The Reformed monthly convents criticized each member's sermon and disputed theological questions (Palatinate 1571, Reformed).

6. Laity: attend, pray at home, commune, be examined (§15.8). Every householder had to bring children and servants to sermon and catechism. Absentees were counted house by house and fined (Nassau-Weilburg 1576). The legal minimum for communion was once or twice a year (Hohenlohe 1588), with Luther's "once or four times" as the ideal. Parents were to teach the catechism at home, and the youth to pray "morning and evening, also before and after meals and at their work" (Dillenburg 1582).

7. Church workers: a higher standard (§15.8.4). Sextons, schoolmasters and organists were held to the conduct required of ministers: "like other ministers of the church, of honest and godly conduct, no drunkards" (Hesse 1566, Moderate Reformed). They were barred from taverns (Hoya 1581) and questioned at visitation about their own communion. The minister's wife, children and servants were inspected with him.

8. Schoolmasters: the catechism as primer (§15.9). The schoolmaster taught the catechism, used it as the reading book, led the boys to sermon and catechism, led the singing, and was visited four times a year by the pastor (Esslingen 1534, Moderate

Reformed; Saxony 1555, 1580). In the towns schoolmistresses brought the girls (Palatinate 1595, Reformed).

9. The magistrate: keeper of both tables (§15.10). The Lutheran magistrate was to "uphold both tables of the Ten Commandments … in maintaining outward discipline" (Mecklenburg 1552). He was the "defender and nourisher" of churches and schools (Transylvania 1572). In practice he:

- ordered visitation;
- appointed and paid ministers;
- enforced attendance;
- punished what the church could only admonish;
- in the Palatinate (1599, 1608, Reformed), refused citizenship and marriage to those who did not know the catechism.

The Reformed limited his office to "the body and temporal goods" (Hanau 1609, Reformed).

10. Catechesis: how often, how long, and what it required (§15.11).

- **Rhythm:** a weekly Sunday catechism of about half an hour, quarterly fortnight-long series (Saxon visitations 1529), a yearly examination in Lent, and house-by-house examinations.
- **Requirement:** the text of the five or six chief parts by heart, and enough understanding to "pray and give a fair account of the chief articles" (Saxony 1555).
- **Before first communion:** at Hohenlohe (1578), children of about twelve were taught "every day for an hour" from Invocavit to Palm Sunday.

11. First communion and confirmation: usually one act (§15.11.3). Where the orders have confirmation, the children are "confirmed and admitted to communion for the first time" together (Hesse 1566, Moderate Reformed). One course of instruction served both. Mansfeld (1580) examined them publicly the day before, monthly. Lauenburg (1585) confirmed twice a year, and Hessen-Kassel (1610, Reformed) heard them again after six months. Where there was no rite, as in Electoral Saxony, examination alone admitted to communion.

12. Infant communion: acknowledged as ancient, set aside (§15.11.6). No order gives the Supper to infants or argues for it. Four orders name the practice:

- Hesse (1566, Moderate Reformed) and Hohenlohe (1578) grant that infants communed in the time of Cyprian and Augustine, but defer the Supper because of 1 Corinthians 11:28 and "the common judgment of the first church". Hesse leaves the old custom "in its worth".
- Oldenburg (1573) says that infants cannot examine themselves or discern the Lord's body.
- The Reformed preacher at Markirch (1561) calls it an error of the ancients, who thought that the uncommunicated were lost.

Children who died before first communion were buried like adults (Regensburg 1572/1588; Henneberg 1582). A dying child who knew the catechism might commune before confirmation (Nassau-Dillenburg 1575, Philippist).

13. Before marriage: examination, not counselling (§§15.11.4–15.11.5). From the 1560s many orders refused to proclaim or marry young people who did not know the catechism (Saxony 1580; Hesse 1566, Moderate Reformed; Pfalz-Veldenz 1574), "since they are to keep house and get children and servants". Some married them on a pledge, backed if need be by sureties, to attend the catechism afterwards (Wied 1616, Reformed). There was no counselling course. What the orders required was:

- an interview some weeks before, on freedom to marry, parents' consent and the catechism (Limpurg 1610: three weeks);
- confession and communion before the wedding (Schwäbisch Hall 1615; Freudenthal 1592);
- the public exhortation and wedding sermon on the duties of marriage.

15.2 Scope, sources and method

15.2.1 Sources and searches

The chapter draws on the full text of the Sehling edition in `eko.db`: the church orders, consistorial and visitation orders, synodal decrees, school and stipend ordinances, and visitation protocols printed with them. The corpus was searched for the vocabulary of each question, in High and Low German and Latin spellings:

- **Offices:** *Pfarrer* (pastor), *Diaconus* (deacon), *Kaplan* (chaplain), *Superintendent*, *Superattendent* (superintendent), *Inspector* (inspector), *Decanus* (dean), *Consistorium* (consistory), *Präsident* (president), *Director*, *Professor*, *facultas theologica* (faculty of theology).
- **Training:** *Stipendium*, *Stipendiat* (stipend-holder), *Alumnus* (alumnus), *Probpredigt* (trial sermon), *examen* (examination), *ordinandus* (ordinand), *Synodus* (synod), *Convent* (convention), *censura* (censure), *studieren* (study), *Bücher* (books).
- **Laity:** *Hausvater* (householder), *Gesinde* (servants), *daheim* (at home), *Kirchgang* (churching), *Strafe* (punishment), *Küster* (sexton), *Opfermann* (sexton), *Schulmeister* (schoolmaster), *Schulfrau* (schoolmistress).
- **Magistrate:** *Obrigkeit* (magistracy), *custos utriusque tabulae* (guardian of both tables), *beide Tafeln* (both tables).
- **Catechesis:** *Katechismus* (catechism), *Kinderlehre* (children's teaching), *Verhör* (examination), *Examen* (examination), *zum ersten Mal* (for the first time) with *Sakrament* (sacrament) or *Nachtmal* (Supper), *confirmieren* (confirm), and *Katechismus* within a short distance of *Braut* (bride), *Eheleute* (married people), *copulieren* (join in marriage), *aufbieten* (call the banns) or *Hochzeit* (wedding).
- **Infant communion:** *kinder* (children), *kindlein* (little children), *unmündig* (under age), *infantes* (infants), *parvuli* (little ones) and *pueri* (boys) within a short distance of *Nachtmal*, *Abendmahl* (Supper), *Sakrament*, *coena* (supper) or *communio* (communion); *prüfe sich selbst* (let him examine himself) and *probet se ipsum* (let him examine himself) near *Kinder* (children); *Cyprian*, *Augustin* and *alte Kirche* (ancient church) near *Kinder*; *Böhmen* (Bohemians), *Picarden* (Picards) and *Hussiten* (Hussites).

Each hit was read in its context. Pages were checked against Sehling's running heads, which often correct the database's record headings. Among the corrections:

- the Mansfeld agenda quoted is of 1580, though its record is dated 1562;
- the Schwäbisch Hall passages on marriage belong to the revision of 1615, not the order of 1543;
- the consistory order of 1608 is Ysenburg-Birstein's (Reformed), and the deacons' rule of 1550 is Breslau's;
- the Palatine passages (Reformed) on probation and convents are from the *Kirchenratsordnung* of 1564 and Wenzel Zuleger's report of 1571, though their record is dated 1585.

15.2.2 What was not found

- **No seminary.** No order founds an institution for training ministers apart from the universities, the stipend houses and the Latin and cloister schools. The word *seminarium* occurs only in the old sense of a "nursery" of church and state.
- **No vicarage year.** No order prescribes a fixed period of practical training under a pastor before ordination. The nearest equivalents are practice preaching (§15.7.2), the probation as deacon (§15.7.4), and Wittenberg's "some weeks" of instruction (§15.7.3).
- **No continuing-education requirement in hours or courses.** Continuing study was enforced through synods, convents, assigned reading and visitation questions (§15.7.5).
- **No premarital counselling course.** Instruction before marriage meant an examination in the catechism and in the freedom to marry, and often confession and communion. The teaching on marriage itself was given publicly in the wedding exhortation and sermon (§15.11.5).
- **No paedocommunion.** No order gives the Supper to infants or defends the practice, and none mentions the Bohemian communion of infants. The orders that name it treat it as an ancient custom now set aside (§15.11.6).
- **No separate confirmation course.** Where confirmation existed it coincided with first communion, and one instruction served both (§15.11.3).
- **No prayer rule for lay church workers.** The lay offices had duties of conduct and attendance, not of prayer. The daily office bound schools and convents, not sextons (§15.8.4).

15.3 Pastors and deacons

15.3.1 The office in a list

The visitation questions. The orders rarely define the pastor's office in the abstract. They list what the visitors are to ask about, and those lists are the best summary of what was expected. Strasbourg's order of 1598 puts the whole office in one sentence and then turns to the minister's life and household. **Strasbourg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1598** (Sehling 20/1, p. 689):

Therefore at the visitation of the church there shall be dealt with: 1. The public office and charge of the ministers of the church (whether there be one or more of them in each place), whether they perform the same with due diligence and faithfulness, as with preaching, giving the sacraments, holding the catechism, blessing weddings, and visiting and comforting the sick and the sorrowful, and other such things; 2. Their life and conduct, the ministers', and also their housekeeping, wife, children and servants.

The same headings recur everywhere: preaching (Chapter 11), the sacraments and the occasional rites (Chapter 13), the catechism (§15.11 below), the sick, and the minister's own life. The daily office laid no breviary obligation on the parish pastor (Chapter 10, §10.6.5).

15.3.2 Study and the pastor's books

A reading list. The Saxon General Articles of 1557 name the books every pastor must read: the Bible, Luther's postil, Melanchthon's *Loci* (Commonplaces), and the Augsburg Confession with its Saxon *Repetition* of 1551. The elector had a copy of the confessions printed for every parish, to stay in the church's inventory. **Electoral Saxony, *General-Artikel und gemeiner Bericht*, 1557** (Sehling 1, p. 322):

They shall bring up their wife and children in discipline and honesty, abstain from all dishonest dealings, also from selling wine or beer, from merchandise and such trades, not revile the people in the pulpit *ex affectu* (out of passion), wait upon their study and office; and especially, besides the Bible, they shall read often and diligently Luther's postils, Philip's *Loci theologici* in Latin or German, [and] the Augsburg Confession together with its aforesaid Repetition, and ground and direct all their sermons and teaching upon these same confessions and declarations, that one form and concord in doctrine may be kept in his Electoral Grace's lands and planted for those that come after.

Books bought by the parish. Where a pastor was too poor to buy them, the parish bought them. Hoya in 1581 orders the churchwardens to provide "a good Wittenberg Bible, Doctor Luther's postils and catechisms", the parish making up any shortfall, "that such books may be bought for the church and remain there" (Sehling 6/2, pp. 1140–1141). The pastor's private study was an item of visitation: the Limpurg visitation order of 1611 asks "what writings and books he readeth, and what his private studies be", and the visitor is to exhort him to study if he is found idle (Sehling 16, p. 627). Synods set reading for the year ahead (§15.7.5).

15.3.3 Life, household and conduct

An example to the flock. The same Saxon articles require ministers and schoolmasters to be "right and pure in doctrine" and blameless in life, to marry, and to keep out of taverns. **Electoral Saxony, *General-Artikel und gemeiner Bericht*, 1557** (Sehling 1, p. 322):

his Electoral Grace will that both ministers of churches and of schools be above all right and pure in doctrine, and otherwise in their life and conduct, both in words, works and clothing, behave themselves honestly towards every man, friendly, chastely and humbly, and in sum everywhere and in all things christianly, and so that they be no stumbling block to any man, and especially to their school- and church-children, but go before with so good an example that the parishioners and every man else may follow them blessedly with delight and fruit and without offence. Whereto it would chiefly serve that they, to avoid human wantonness and the suspicion that followeth from it, enter into holy matrimony, […] wait diligently upon their office and study, [and] abstain from drinking, from walking abroad and other offensive frivolity, and from all taverns and ale-houses.

The articles allow a pastor to sell by the cask the wine or beer of his own glebe or tithe, "only that they hang out no tavern sign nor set guests to drink in the house" (Sehling 1, p. 322). Their dress is treated in Chapter 14, §14.8.

The household inspected. The minister's wife, children and servants were visited with him. The Württemberg visitation order of 1559 tells the special superintendent to find out "whether the ministers instruct their children in prayer and the catechism, and keep their boys at school or teach them themselves at home", and to ask each pastor about the "doctrine, life and housekeeping" of his colleagues and neighbours "and of their wives and children" (Sehling 16, p. 387). A Württemberg visitation order of 1547 gives the reason from 1 Timothy 3: "he that ruleth not his house well, how shall he rule the house of the Lord?" (Sehling 16, p. 151). The Oldenburg visitation articles of 1609 ask the parish "how the pastor's wife and children behave themselves towards divine service and live" (Sehling 7/2.1, p. 1192).

15.3.4 Residence and records

Residence. A pastor was not to leave his parish overnight without leave and a substitute. **Hoya, *Kirchenordnung*, 1581** (Sehling 6/2, p. 1140):

Therefore we command all and every one of our pastors, schoolmasters and sextons that none betake himself long from his parish and office, be it one night or more, without needful cause, and [unless] each have taken leave of our appointed inspectors in his appointed office, and have procured and appointed a fit and well-known person out of his neighbourhood in our county [to serve] in his absence.

Marienhafe in East Frisia copied the rule in 1593 (Sehling 7/1, p. 728). In the towns the deacons needed the pastor's leave, as at Breslau in 1550 and Regensburg in 1556 (Sehling 3, p. 418; 13, p. 443).

The parish register. From mid-century the pastor kept registers of baptisms, marriages and burials, and the visitors inspected them. **Saxony, *Kirchenordnung*, 1580** (Sehling 1, p. 397):

And that it may be certain that every pastor in his church, according to our order, keepeth a list and register of the newly baptized children together with their parents' and godparents' names, on what day they were baptized, likewise of the names of the new married folk, on what day they were wedded and held their wedding, and also on what day each one died, the visitor, as often as he visiteth, shall have that same book, wherein all this is orderly written, brought before him.

The register was to stay with the church and not leave with the pastor or his widow. Nassau-Weilburg (1576) adds confirmations (Sehling 10, p. 307), and some orders add the communicants (Kapellendorf 1569, Sehling 1, p. 583). In Pirna (1578) the sexton kept the book, and at Regensburg (1572) he kept the register of the dead (Sehling 1, p. 645; 13, p. 509).

15.3.5 Deacons and chaplains

The assistant ministers. The *Diaconus* (deacon) or *Kaplan* (chaplain) was an ordained assistant (Chapter 16, §16.5.1). His particular charges were the catechism and the sick. **Electoral Saxony, *Generalia, alle superintendentes belangende*, 1555** (Sehling 1, p. 315):

They shall diligently set forth the catechism to the youth, and in teaching it not seek to show their art and skill, but say the children's doctrine before the unlearned young folk in the simplest way and always in one form and manner, and so require it again of them and examine [them]. In visiting the sick they shall be willing and unwearied, and readier to serve the poor herein than the rich.

They were to honour and obey their pastor and superintendent and "not belittle them before the congregation, nor practise against them, nor stir up factions" (Sehling 1, p. 315). The deacon was chosen by the pastor together with the council (Sehling 1, p. 323).

15.4 Superintendents and deans

15.4.1 The name and the office

One overseer, many names. The evangelical orders replaced the bishop's oversight with a superintendent (*Superattendens*, *Inspector*, *Dechant*, *Decanus*, *Propst*). Augsburg in 1537 (Moderate Reformed) justifies the office from the apostolic church and says outright that the titles are one. **Augsburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1537** (Moderate Reformed; Sehling 12, p. 55):

therefore among the apostles, and afterwards in the churches, there have always been appointed in every congregation one or very few chief overseers, leaders, superattendents or bishops, which names all mean one thing, that here the flock be not the worse kept through many shepherds [...] In sum: they shall in all things have upon them, oversee and provide the highest care and provision of the congregation of Christ.

At Augsburg (1537, Moderate Reformed) the office rotated quarterly between the council's president and the senior provost. In the territories it was a standing office. Its installation is in Chapter 13, §13.11.4.

15.4.2 Electoral Saxony, 1555–1557: visitation, synod, report

The Saxon pattern. The Saxon General Articles of 1557 set out the superintendent's duties that most later Lutheran orders follow:

- watch over "the doctrine, life and diligence" of all pastors and church servants in his district;
- summon the village pastors once a year, and visit unannounced, to hear their sermons, ask the parishioners about their pastor's conduct, examine the youth in the catechism and inspect the schools;
- hold a synod every year;
- admonish privately, and report what he cannot mend to the consistory.

Electoral Saxony, *General-Artikel und gemeiner Bericht*, 1557 (Sehling 1, pp. 320–321):

Moreover every superattendent shall, as it suiteth him and the neighbouring pastors, hold a synod every year between Easter and Whitsun, and call thereto out of the towns, market towns and villages all the pastors that belong to his superintendency, and therein inquire into their doctrine and manners and other defects that fall out, and bring the same to amendment; and especially hear their report, how they have found their parishioners in the examination, and what other erroneous matters they have to declare. And if anything fell out that he could not settle, he shall refer it and bring it to the consistory to which the person and matter belong. And if the superattendent himself have learned of anything unseemly or blameworthy in any pastor belonging to his superintendency, or have received information of it from the patron or the parishioners, he shall speak to him about it in secret and rebuke him according to the circumstances of the offence, with warning that, if no amendment followed and more complaints of the like came before him, he must bring it before the consistory.

Other charges. The superintendent also:

- examined candidates for a parish before sending them to Wittenberg or Leipzig for ordination (§15.7.3);
- installed new pastors before the altar and charged both pastor and people (Sehling 1, p. 321);
- saw that no pastor was dismissed without his knowledge (Sehling 1, p. 312);
- settled the widow's year and the parish inventory when a pastor died (Sehling 1, p. 312).

The 1555 *Generalia* add a yearly meeting of all the superintendents of the Electoral circle at Wittenberg on the Wednesday after Whitsun, where they reported to the pastor of Wittenberg "as the upper superintendent" (Sehling 1, p. 312). The visitor's travelling costs were refunded on a weekly account sent to the elector "into his own hands" (Sehling 1, p. 311).

15.4.3 The superintendent's charge: Grubenhagen, 1600

An instruction under oath. The Brunswick consistory's instruction for the superintendent of Grubenhagen, on which he was sworn in 1600, shows the office at the end of the century: guardian of doctrine, visitor, and agent of the consistory. **Grubenhagen, *Officium superintendentis Grubenhagici*, 1600** (Sehling 6/2, p. 1109):

1. That he bind himself to teach in sound understanding, wholly in accord with the *Corpus doctrinae Julium* and the Formula of Concord, *in thesi et antithesi* (in thesis and antithesis), and to keep diligent oversight that the pastors under him may do the like. […] 4. That he hold no village or house exempt from his superintendency, nor pass over anyone in his appointed visitation within the district put under him […] 5. The superintendent shall overlook no public sin or offensive dealing in the pastors and ministers of the church.

He was to change no ceremony without the consistory's ruling, to act always *pro matrimonio* (in favour of marriage) in marriage cases, and to settle small matters with the district governor rather than "trouble the consistory lightly" (Sehling 6/2, p. 1109).

15.4.4 Deans of the Transylvanian chapters

Elected deans. Among the Transylvanian Saxons the pastors of each chapter elected their own dean (*decanus*). **Transylvania, Statutes of the Chapter of Lasseln, 1572** (Sehling 24, p. 361):

The office of the dean is to act as inspector of the churches and schools of his diocese, and to take care to the utmost of his power that heresies, schisms and vices of manners spring not up. Next, to watch over the common good, and to call the brethren to assembly only for some sufficient and weighty cause. Besides this, to defend the good and innocent against all wrongs done them within and without the chapter. But on the other hand to punish most severely the rebellious, the slothful, the drones, and those who in any way bring disgrace both privately on themselves and openly on the whole brotherhood.

For his pains each brother paid him one florin a year. The chapter also judged marriage cases, "which pious magistrates of old, not without weighty counsel, referred to the ecclesiastical court" (Sehling 24, pp. 361–362).

15.5 Consistories, their presidents and members

15.5.1 Composition: theologians and jurists

A mixed court. The consistory was a standing court of theologians and lawyers under the prince, for marriage cases, church discipline and the affairs of ministers and church property. Wittenberg's of 1539 had two theologians and two doctors of law, mostly professors of the university (Sehling 7/2.2, p. 306, n. 2). Jena's in 1569 was presided over by the superintendent of Jena, who was to be a doctor of theology. **Saxe-Weimar, *Ordnung und reformation ecclesiastici consistorii zu Jena*, 1569** (Sehling 1, p. 234):

We ordain and will also that in this consistory the superintendent of Jena, who shall be a doctor of theology, be president, and that two other theologians, out of the professors or the ministers of the church, and then two able, God-fearing jurists, and our district officer there, or another person of the nobility, be joined to him as assessors.

15.5.2 The president: prince, nobleman or councillor

Who presided. The orders disagree about who should preside:

- **The prince himself.** At Weimar in 1561 Duke Johann Friedrich made himself "the supreme president" and meant to attend "in our own princely person", with his brothers deputizing (Sehling 1, pp. 230–231).
- **A theologian.** At Jena in 1569 the superintendent presided (above).
- **A nobleman.** Electoral Saxony in 1580 set over its upper consistory at Dresden "an understanding, well-qualified [man] of the nobility as president and director of all the consistories' affairs", with two jurists and two theologians, the court superintendent and the preacher of Dresden (Sehling 1, p. 405).
- **A lay councillor, to keep the clergy from the sword.** Regensburg in 1588 gave the presidency to one of the political members. **Regensburg, *Ordnung des consistorii*, 1588** (Sehling 13, pp. 513–514):

and that in this respect also the consistory's authority towards all persons summoned and cited before it may henceforth be upheld, as is fitting and need requireth, and the ministers of the church set free from the suspicion that they would again lay hold on the worldly sword and rule in the church at their pleasure like the Pope, the office of president and the direction of the consistory shall be committed to one of the three learned political men appointed to the consistory, who is judged fitter for it than the others *propter authoritatem, eruditionem et prudentiam* (for authority, learning and prudence).

Pfalz-Neuburg (1576) likewise set "a director among the three political councillors" (Sehling 13, p. 237).

What the president did. The director:

- put the business to the members and took the vote, "the *umbfrage*", alternating clerical and lay members at his discretion (Hanau 1612, Reformed, Sehling 10, p. 539);
- alone made the proposals, "to avoid confusion and ill-will" (Ysenburg-Birstein 1608, Reformed, Sehling 10, p. 686).

The Saxon president of 1580 also gave each newly examined pastor a formal charge on his office before he was sent to his parish (Sehling 1, p. 380).

15.5.3 The business of the consistory

Its competence. Electoral Saxony in 1580 sets out the matters that belonged to the consistory, so that "worldly and church courts be not mixed together". **Saxony, *Kirchenordnung*, 1580** (Sehling 1, p. 403):

First, all marriage cases, whatever their names, which cannot be settled and composed by the superintendents and the authorities of each place according to the order given them. All offensive sins and vices in teachers and hearers against the first and second table of God's commandments, so far only as concerneth the degrees of admonition, and not the worldly punishment, as these have been ordained in the synods. All matters concerning pastors, ministers of churches and schools: their calling, office, service, life, conduct, translation, dismissal, suspension, dealings and offences, in the measure set down for the

synods. All matters concerning the goods, fiefs, income, use, buildings and repair of churches, schools, hospitals and common chests, and also the salaries of the ministers of the church.

The Saxon upper consistory also had a "general inspection and oversight" of the universities of Leipzig and Wittenberg, the princely schools and the two lower consistories. Books were not to be printed without the consistory's censorship (Sehling 1, pp. 402, 407). Brandenburg-Ansbach (1594) forbade booksellers to sell "new, impure, suspect books" without the consistory's knowledge, and set the president and political councillors over the endowments of churches and schools (Sehling 11, p. 382).

Sessions and secrecy. The consistories met weekly:

- Hanau (1612, Reformed): every Tuesday afternoon from one o'clock until evening, with extraordinary sessions at the director's discretion (Sehling 10, p. 538);
- Ysenburg-Birstein (1608, Reformed): every Wednesday afternoon from one until four or five, members arriving late being fined (Sehling 10, p. 685).

Members, secretary and copyists swore to keep the business "in the highest secrecy" (Brandenburg- Ansbach 1594, Sehling 11, p. 385; Pfalz-Neuburg 1576, Sehling 13, p. 240).

15.6 Professors of theology

No seminaries. No order founds a seminary in the later sense. Ministers were trained at the universities, often on a territorial stipend (§15.7), and the church orders treat the professors of theology only where their work touched the church's government.

What the orders ask of professors.

- **Sitting in the consistory.** The Wittenberg and Jena consistories drew on the theology faculty (§15.5.1), and the Prussian consistorial order of 1584 names "the *primarius professor theologiae* at the university" among its three theologians (Sehling 4, p. 123). Because the Saxon consistorials of Leipzig and Wittenberg "each also hath his profession at the high school", their sessions were to be timed "that they be in no way hindered in their lectures, and the youth not neglected in their studies" (Sehling 1, p. 402).
- **Examining and ordaining.** Candidates were examined and ordained at Wittenberg and Leipzig (Saxony 1557, Sehling 1, p. 321), at Marburg before "the teachers of God's word and the professors of holy Scripture" (Hesse 1566, Moderate Reformed, Sehling 8, p. 201), and by the theological faculty of Helmstedt, which was not to keep a candidate more than two days nor take more than two thalers (Gandersheim recess 1601, Sehling 6/2, p. 892).
- **Overseeing the stipendiaries.** The prefect of the Marburg stipendiaries examined them twice a year "in the presence of all the professors of theology, that the examination may have the more weight and the wits be stirred to greater diligence". **Hesse, *Stipendiatenordnung*, 1546** (Moderate Reformed; Sehling 8, p. 159):

Fourthly, he shall examine them all twice a year in the presence of all the professors of theology, that the examination may have so much the more authority, and the wits be stirred up to greater diligence.

- **Lecturing the clergy.** Braunschweig-Wolfenbüttel (1543) appointed at the cathedral "a *lector theologiae*, who is charged with nothing else than to read some lessons publicly in holy Scripture" (Sehling 6/1, p. 47). The monks and canons in the monasteries were to hear such lectures every weekday morning and evening, "that afterwards, learned in the word of God, they may be set over churches and schools" (Sehling 6/1, p. 81).
- **The academy and the church.** At Strasbourg the church convent and the academy quarrelled over seats and over "the provision and ordering of the theological lectures and disputations"; an agreement of 1575 settled it (Sehling 20/1, p. 507).

15.7 Training of ministers

15.7.1 School, university and stipend

No seminary, no vicarage. The orders know nothing of a seminary or of a vicarage year in the modern sense. The path to the ministry ran through the Latin school and the university, and the churches paid for it with stipends:

- **Territorial stipends.** Electoral Saxony raised "the number of our stipendiaries … who shall all be drawn to the service of churches and schools" (1580, Sehling 1, p. 376).
- **Stipends on vacant benefices.** The Saxon visitors of 1540 meant to turn church fiefs into stipends as they fell vacant (Sehling 1, p. 288).
- **Stipends from the old monastic goods.** Nassau in 1546 created stipends of 24 florins a year from surplus church income, for boys of at least seventeen (Sehling 10, p. 88).
- **Boarding colleges.** Württemberg's boys passed from the *Pädagogium* (paedagogium) at Stuttgart and the cloister schools to the *Stipendium* at Tübingen (1559, Sehling 16, p. 359). The Reformed Palatinate admitted to its stipend only those found fit in the half-yearly examinations of its four *paedagogia* (1593, Sehling 14, p. 553).

Stipendiaries were bound by a written obligation to serve the territory that paid for them (Württemberg 1559, Sehling 16, p. 364; Hohenlohe 1556, Sehling 15, p. 108).

15.7.2 Practice preaching in the stipend: Tübingen, 1559

Preaching under correction. The Tübingen *Stipendium* is the nearest thing in the orders to a training house for preachers. After the master's degree each stipendiary heard the theology lectures, studied Greek and Hebrew, and preached in the house until he was called. **Württemberg, *Ordnung des Tübinger Stipendiums*, 1559** (Sehling 17/1, p. 561):

Every one, after attaining the degree of Master, shall be bound in the study of theology, according to this ordinance, without delay to hear the theological lectures diligently, besides the study of the Greek and Hebrew tongues, and to exercise himself in preaching in the Stipendium, so long and until one or more of them be called to the ministry.

The texts were assigned to them, not chosen. They were to handle them by "an understanding, right and orderly method, according to the precepts of dialectic and rhetoric". The superintendents of the house were to tell a preacher "privately, the same day, after the sermon is held", any faults they found "in invention, disposition or delivery" (Sehling 17/1, p. 561). The stipendiaries also kept "their disputations, declamations and exercises of style" in the arts faculty (Sehling 17/1, p. 577). The Coburg synod of 1580 asked for a similar house with "*exercitia disputationum, repetitionum, concionum*" led by *magistri repetentes* (Sehling 1, p. 253).

Preaching in the parish. A young man could also practise in a parish pulpit, with the pastor's leave and on showing his sermon first. **Electoral Saxony, *Generalia, alle superintendentes belangende*, 1555** (Sehling 1, p. 314):

But if a young fellow, who desireth to try and exercise himself, should ask leave to preach, the pastor shall allow it him, yet so that the young fellow first lay before him someone's written testimony and the draft of the sermon he purposeth, in writing or by mouth.

Schwäbisch Hall's synod ruled in 1606 that no student of theology "who will exercise himself in preaching" should do so without the dean's consent (Sehling 17/1, p. 191).

15.7.3 Examination, trial sermon and instruction before ordination

The examination. Before ordination the candidate was examined in doctrine and had to preach. **Electoral Saxony, *General-Artikel und gemeiner Bericht*, 1557** (Sehling 1, p. 322):

And among other things the ordinand shall be asked before ordination where and what he hath studied, also where and wherewith he hath before maintained and supported himself; finally also be diligently examined in Christian doctrine, and preach publicly once or oftener. And if it be found that he is unfit in doctrine and life, those that sent him and have called, or would call, him to the parish shall be informed in writing of his unfitness and warned to think upon another who is fit for such a pastoral office.

The trial sermon (*Probpredigt*) became standard. In the Reformed Palatinate it was to show "how he can teach the common people out of Scripture, exhort them to amendment and comfort them", with attention to "his pronunciation" (Kirchenratsordnung 1564, Sehling 14, p. 412). Henneberg sent the candidate to preach before the parish, which reported back "how the man sent pleased them with his person, delivery, bearing [and] repute" (1555, Sehling 2, p. 294).

Weeks of instruction at Wittenberg. A candidate who was teachable but not yet fit was not simply rejected. The superintendent was to send him to Wittenberg "with warning that he be provided beforehand by those that called him to the

pastorate with needful expenses, that he may be instructed at Wittenberg some weeks, if need be, and await ordination without burdening anyone" (Saxony 1555, Sehling 1, p. 312). Hesse in 1566 (Moderate Reformed) told examiners to keep promising candidates at Marburg for a time. **Hesse, *Kirchenordnung*, 1566** (Moderate Reformed; Sehling 8, p. 201):

But if the examiners find some of those that are sent to the examination [not yet] fit, they shall exhort them to stay a while, to attend the lectures diligently, and especially to exercise themselves well in holy Scripture, that afterwards they may come to the examination better prepared.

15.7.4 Probation: deacon before pastor

The diaconate as apprenticeship. The closest thing to a vicarage is the rule that a new man should first serve as deacon under a pastor. **Palatinate, *Kirchenratsordnung*, 1564** (Reformed; Sehling 14, p. 413):

And no novice that hath not been in the ministry before shall lightly be entrusted with a parish, unless one be so able, old and experienced that it appeared from the circumstances and his bearing that he could have charge of a parish; then one may well entrust a parish to him, but otherwise not lightly. Rather he shall first be used as a deacon, and after some time, when one would commit a parish to him, be examined again, that one may judge thereby whether he hath increased in doctrine.

The Palatine *Kirchenratsordnung* of about 1593 (Reformed) repeats the rule (Sehling 14, p. 548). In 1607 the Elector's church council found that "the young *sapientisten* and other new ministers sent out mostly do not increase but decrease". **Palatinate, *Mandat zu den Konventen, der Predigtaufsicht und den Diakonen*, 1607** (Reformed; Sehling 19/2, p. 957):

We command you therefore that from all such new deacons, when they have been a year in your inspection, you require their outlines of sermons, censure the same according to the aforementioned *Ecclesiastes* of Bucanus, write your censures above them, and send them to us, that we also may read them before they be cited hither, show them their faults therein, and then give them their outlines back.

Elsewhere the new man stood under the eye of his superintendent. Pfalz-Neuburg's consistory kept "a book … wherein every pastor's or minister's name and surname, age, where he studied, how he stood in the examination, [how he] held [himself] in the trial sermon" were written (Pfalz-Neuburg 1576, Sehling 13, p. 172; Hohenlohe 1580, Sehling 15, p. 491).

15.7.5 Continuing study: synods, convents and assigned reading

Reading set from synod to synod. The yearly synod was also a school for the pastors. The Saxon superintendent was to give his pastors "a useful little book, or a piece of the Bible, to read this coming year", on which they would hear one another at the next synod (1555, Sehling 1, p. 312). Nassau-Dillenburg in 1552 made the same rule into an examination. **Nassau-Dillenburg, *Synodalabschied*, 1552** (Sehling 10, p. 93):

that in every synod one or more *loci* shall be set before the priests, to be repeated and thoroughly examined at the next synod following, and then another or more set, to be examined at the following synod, and so forth, that the priests may be moved the more diligently to read and the sooner to buy books.

Monthly convents with sermon criticism. The Reformed Palatinate made the convent of the pastors a monthly exercise. The president of the church council reported to the Elector in 1571. **Palatinate, Wenzel Zuleger's report on the classical convents, [1571]** (Reformed; Sehling 14, p. 446):

First, the ministers of churches and schools are commanded to come together once every month, at their own cost, at appointed places. There one of them shall expound a passage of Scripture in German in the convent, after the manner of a sermon. When this is done he shall withdraw, and the other ministers judge whether he hath set forth the meaning of the text rightly, understandably and edifyingly, and drawn from it doctrine, exhortation and rebuke rightly and to edification. Where he faileth, he shall be told so in a friendly way and exhorted to amend. After that the president […] shall propose a couple of theological questions, [which] they [shall] handle among themselves in Latin, or in German where it is edifying.

The later Palatine and Hanau convent orders (1607, 1609, both Reformed) turned this into a full procedure, with the pastors bound by oath to "submit willingly to the censure of my brethren" (Sehling 14, p. 609; 10, p. 542).

Trial sermons for serving pastors. In Brandenburg the village pastors took turns preaching trial sermons at the weekday service in the town church, besides the yearly convents, "that they may be better informed in the articles of faith and the controversies

of religion … and have occasion for more diligence in the study of doctrine" (visitation recess of 1600, Sehling 3, p. 212). At Neuruppin in 1558 the rural pastors were, in Sehling's summary, to be summoned, examined and made to preach once a quarter (Sehling 3, p. 264).

15.8 The laity

15.8.1 Attending church

Sermon and catechism. Every order requires attendance at the Sunday sermon, and most the afternoon catechism. The duty fell on the head of the household for children and servants. **Hohenlohe, *Polizei- und Rügordnung*, 1588** (Sehling 15, p. 594):

Every man shall attend the sermon on Sundays and holy days, and send and hold his children and servants thereto. Every one that hath reached his understanding shall receive the Supper at the least once or twice in the year.

Counted and fined. In Nassau-Weilburg church censors went round during the service to note those in the streets, churchyard, taverns, workshops or barns. In the villages the people were counted house by house. **Nassau-Weilburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1576** (Sehling 10, p. 309):

that especially in market towns and villages, above all on Sundays and on the higher feasts, holy days and prayer days, a count be made from house to house before the church, and those found absent without weighty cause and without leave asked beforehand be punished without fail with a fixed fine or church penance, according to this order of censure.

No one was exempt: not the lords' servants, nor those in privileged houses, nor millers, bakers, innkeepers, journeymen and carters (Sehling 10, p. 309). Belzig in 1529 already bound "all householders" to send children and servants to the quarterly catechism sermons on pain of punishment by the district officer and the council (Sehling 1, p. 527). Where a war or plague service was called by the bell, Hohenlohe in 1588 required "at the least one person out of every house" to come, and those at home to pray with them (Sehling 15, p. 542).

15.8.2 Prayer and teaching at home

The household as a church. The orders assume that the head of the household teaches the catechism at home and leads prayer, as Luther's Small Catechism directs ("how a householder should teach his household"). Brandenburg-Nürnberg (1533) has the pastors exhort parents. **Brandenburg-Nürnberg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1533** (Sehling 11, p. 188):

They shall also diligently exhort the parents and householders to draw their children and household to the sermon and to common prayer, and especially to take heed that they withdraw not themselves too long from the holy sacrament without honest cause.

Saxony in 1580 tells parents to teach their children and servants "at home in the chief parts of the catechism" before sending them to confession, "for some are found so unskilled that they know not even what the holy sacrament is" (Sehling 1, p. 427). The Reformed synod of Dillenburg in 1582 sent pastors and elders into the houses. **Nassau-Dillenburg, *Abschied der Dillenburger Generalsynode*, 1582** (Reformed; Sehling 10, p. 173):

1. The pastors, or the seniors and presbyters, shall hold domestic visitation, wherein they shall exhort and edify the people with all friendliness, and especially see to it that the youth be held at home, morning and evening, also before and after meals and at their work, to prayer and to the singing of psalms.

The bells called the absent to prayer as well: when the Litany began, Hohenlohe in 1581 had the great bell rung "so that every man in the field or in the houses be reminded of the common prayer", to join it "in spirit" though absent in body (Sehling 15, p. 452; Chapter 9).

15.8.3 Confession and communion

How often. The orders cite Luther's preface to the Small Catechism: whoever does not seek the sacrament "at the least once or four times a year" is to be feared a despiser of it (Palatinate 1556, Sehling 14, p. 135; Danzig 1557, Sehling 4, p. 230). The legal minimum was usually once or twice a year (Hohenlohe 1588, above). The Schulenburg order of 1572 had pastors admonish and then report to the lords those who did not go "at the least once or twice in the year" to confession and the sacrament, "and such

a one shall not be suffered in the parish at all" (Sehling 3, p. 149). Before communion every communicant went to confession or to the examination (*Verhör*) (Chapter 3).

Private confession and absolution are treated in Chapter 13, §13.17.

15.8.4 Church workers: a higher standard

Lay officers held to the minister's standard. Sextons, organists, schoolmasters and church wardens were not ordained, but the orders held them to the conduct required of ministers. Hesse in 1566 (Moderate Reformed) says so of the sextons ("*Opfermänner*"). **Hesse, *Kirchenordnung*, 1566** (Moderate Reformed; Sehling 8, p. 211):

These also, like other ministers of the church, shall be of honest and godly conduct, no drunkards, nor ply dishonest trades. And the said sextons shall be taken on thereto by the pastors and elders with the knowledge and will of a superintendent.

Oldenburg in 1573 complained that "godless knaves who go about with the black art, soothsaying, charming, conjuring devils, treasure-digging, also with blasphemy, drunkenness and other offensive wicked pieces" had been taken on as sextons (Sehling 7/2.1, p. 1121). Hoya (1581) forbade "our pastors, schoolmasters and sextons" to be found "in offensive company in common drinking-bouts and public taverns" (Sehling 6/2, p. 1141). Visitors asked about the sexton's communion as about the pastor's. In the Oldenburg visitation protocols of 1609, quoted in Sehling's notes, one sexton was found "not yet [to have gone] *ad coenam*", and another had kept from the sacrament nine years over a quarrel (Sehling 7/2.1, pp. 1185, 1189).

The minister's household. The higher standard reached the minister's wife, children and servants (§15.3.3). The elders of the Reformed churches were to be "blameless" by the rule of 1 Timothy 3; their duties are in Chapter 16, §16.6. No order found lays a special prayer rule on the minor offices; their duty was attendance, good conduct, and the service of the choir or the church door.

15.9 Schoolmasters

15.9.1 A church office

Teacher, singer and catechist. The schoolmaster was counted among the "ministers of churches and schools" and was bound to the same life (§15.3.3). His church duties were:

- to teach the catechism and prayers;
- to lead the boys in church and lead the singing;
- to bring them to the sermon and watch them there;
- to obey the pastor and the visitors.

His installation and oath are in Chapter 13, §13.12.3, and the choir service in Chapter 10, §10.6.1. Esslingen's ten articles for the German schoolmaster (1534, Moderate Reformed) are the shortest complete statement. **Esslingen, *Artikel für den deutschen Schulmeister*, [1534]** (Moderate Reformed; Sehling 17/2, p. 381):

1. He shall endeavour to instruct the children and bring them up in the fear of God, discipline and honesty, according to the holy gospel and the daily sermons. […] 3. The schoolmaster shall so behave himself in teaching and in his whole life that the children take no evil example from him, as becometh a Christian, faithful teacher. 4. The questions, the small and great children's instruction, shall be kept in constant use in the school and given to the children for spelling and reading instead of the name-book, before they take up other letters or books. 5. He shall diligently lead the children to the sermons, namely on Sunday, and on Wednesday to the children's instruction. […] 7. He shall exercise the children well in the Ten Commandments, the Creed, the Our Father, the sacraments, in singing psalms and the like, as the booklets of questions direct. 8. The great questions they shall read; the small they shall learn by heart.

The catechism thus served as the reading primer.

15.9.2 In church with the boys

Leading them to the sermon. In the towns the German schoolmasters brought their pupils to the weekday sermon and sang before and after it, so that the Latin school need not lose its hours. **Saxony, *Kirchenordnung*, 1580** (Sehling 1, p. 370):

it is deemed advisable, where there are German schools in a town, that the same schoolmasters come with their boys into the church at the right time, when the bell is rung for the sermon, and sing with them a German hymn or two, whereupon the sermon shall follow; and when it is ended, a German hymn shall again be sung by them together with the people.

At Wittenberg (1533) a school servant sat with the boys who could not get into the pew, "to see that they hear the sermon and play no knavery" (Sehling 1, p. 703). In Norderdithmarschen (1597) the boys gathered at their teacher's house before the service on Sundays and feasts and went with him "in orderly, modest array into the church, to hear the sermon and help with the singing" (Sehling 23, p. 502). The Oschatz visitors of 1555 wanted the boys "held to diligent attention and to noting down the sayings from God's word, and always diligently asked what they have learned from the sermon" (Sehling 1, p. 631).

15.9.3 Girls' schools and schoolmistresses

Schoolmistresses. Girls had their own schools in the larger towns, with schoolmistresses or a schoolmaster for the girls:

- Brück (1530) has the schoolmaster teach "the young maidens … under eleven years with reading and writing, also in the catechism and good sayings of Scripture" (Sehling 1, p. 535);
- Wittenberg's maidens came on weekday mornings while the sermon bell rang (1533, Sehling 1, p. 706);
- in the Reformed Palatinate in 1595 "every schoolmaster" was to lead his boys, and "every schoolwoman her schoolgirls", to the catechism sermon and present them to the ministers (Sehling 19/2, p. 856).

15.9.4 Oversight

Visited by the pastor. The pastor visited the school. Saxony in 1555 required the pastors, "at the least four times every year", with a burgomaster or councillor, to "view the schools, examine the children", and see that the school servants "live without offence … and abstain from frivolous clothing, also from ale-houses, gluttony and such vices" (Sehling 1, p. 313). The Württemberg special superintendent asked "whether the schoolmaster with his colleagues keep the school in order and at its time … and furnish the church with Christian hymns, and what conduct he and his colleagues lead" (1559, Sehling 16, p. 388).

15.10 The magistrate

15.10.1 Keeper of both tables

Lutheran doctrine. The Lutheran orders follow Melanchthon in making the Christian magistrate "keeper of both tables" of the Law: responsible not only for the second table (civil order) but for the first (true worship), so far as outward discipline goes. Mecklenburg in 1552 states it plainly. **Mecklenburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1552** (Sehling 5, p. 189):

But the worldly authority oweth God this service in the whole divine, eternal law: that is, first, they shall put away and punish all outward, known idolatry, sorcery, perjury, blasphemy, open heresy, and on the other hand let true doctrine of God be planted and help to maintain it […] And in sum, the authority shall uphold both tables of the Ten Commandments, to the honour of God, in maintaining outward discipline with earnest execution.

The Palatinate repeated the passage almost word for word in 1556 (Sehling 14, p. 219).

Nourisher of churches and schools. The Transylvanian Saxons add the image of the magistrate as foster-father of the church, from Isaiah 49:23. **Transylvania, *Bekenntnisformel der Mediascher Synode*, 1572** (Sehling 24, p. 349):

for whose preservation there is need of churches and schools and their teachers, of which pious magistrates ought to be defenders and nourishers, as it is said in the 49th chapter of Isaiah. The Christian magistrate ought also to remove manifest offences out of the church, such as idolatry and impious doctrines contrary to the word of God, and horrible blasphemies against God.

15.10.2 What the magistrate did

Duties in practice. The magistrate's duties were these:

- **To order visitation.** The prince sent the visitors and gave the reason. **Lüneburg, *Instruktion zu den Visitationen*, 1565** (Sehling 6/1, p. 576):

Because the Almighty hath set us in this high office of authority, so that we acknowledge ourselves bound above all things to further God's honour and the souls and salvation of the subjects committed to us, and to take care that his word be taught clear and pure, the sacraments rightly administered, all offences removed, good discipline and Christian order maintained.

- **To appoint, pay and protect ministers.** Patrons and councils called ministers, but subject to the superintendent's examination (§§15.4, 15.7). The Saxon articles forbade patrons to charge "fief money" or to dismiss a pastor without cause shown before the consistory (1557, Sehling 1, p. 321). Councils paid ministers and schoolmasters from the common chest.
- **To enforce attendance and the Sabbath.** The district officer and council punished those who kept children and servants from the catechism (Belzig 1529, Sehling 1, p. 527). Absentees were fined (Nassau-Weilburg 1576, §15.8.1), and at Dillenburg in 1618 (Reformed) the fines went into the alms chest (Sehling 10, p. 203).
- **To punish what the church could only admonish.** The consistory handled "the degrees of admonition, and not the worldly punishment" (Saxony 1580, §15.5.3). What the church could not mend went to the magistrate: the Schulenburg lords were to punish or expel those who would not come to the sacrament (1572, Sehling 3, p. 149).
- **To refuse citizenship and marriage to the ignorant.** The Reformed Elector Palatine in 1599 and 1608 forbade his officials to admit anyone as a citizen, or let anyone marry, who did not know the catechism (§15.11.4).
- **To be preached to.** At Schwäbisch Hall a sermon "on the office of the magistrate" was preached each year before the council election (1615, Sehling 17/1, p. 165). The visitor began each rural visitation with an exhortation "on the office of Christian magistrates … namely, among other things, to take the church diligently in hand after the example of the pious King of Judah, Jehoshaphat" (Sehling 17/1, p. 186).

15.10.3 The Reformed limit

Bodies, not souls. The Reformed orders drew the line more sharply. **Hanau-Münzenberg, *Presbyteriumsordnung*, [1609]** (Reformed; Sehling 10, p. 512):

For first, the office of the magistrate extendeth only over the body and temporal goods of the subjects, but over the souls of men and their eternal welfare they have no rule at all. On the other hand, the office of the elders goeth to the consciences of men, which they rouse out of sin by their admonition, crush with the hammer of the divine law and lead to God, and raise up and comfort again by the promise of grace of the gospel.

Even so, a Hanau sermon plan of 1609 (Reformed) still called the magistrate *custos utriusque tabulae quoad disciplinam externam*, keeper of both tables as far as outward discipline goes (Sehling 10, p. 469). The ceremonies by which magistrates were installed and prayed for are in Chapter 13, §13.13.

15.11 Catechesis: where the estates meet

Catechesis was the one duty shared by every estate:

- the pastor and deacon preached and examined;
- the schoolmaster drilled;
- the householder repeated it at home;
- the magistrate compelled attendance;
- the superintendent tested the results at visitation and synod.

The confirmation rites themselves are in Chapter 13, §13.6, and the catechism sermon in Chapter 11, §11.4.3. The catechism service itself, its hour, length and order, is in Chapter 10, §10.10.

15.11.1 How often and how long

Three rhythms. The orders combine three rhythms of catechism teaching:

- **Weekly.** A catechism sermon or children's instruction on Sunday afternoon, often with a weekday repetition: Wednesday and Friday at Reuss (1528), "always half an hour" (Sehling 2, p. 151). The sermon was to last no more than half an hour (Nassau-Weilburg 1576, Sehling 10, p. 235). In a filial village the Sunday sermon was split, "half an hour" for the gospel and the other half for the catechism, said "word for word without exposition" (Eisfeld 1554, Sehling 1, p. 562).

- **Quarterly series.** The Saxon visitors of 1529 ordered the catechism preached four times a year, a fortnight each time, with penalties for householders who did not send their children and servants. **Belzig, *Ordnung der Stadt Belzig*, 1529** (Sehling 1, p. 527):

Likewise that the catechism be preached four times in the year, each time at the least fourteen days one after another, whither we bind all householders to send their children and servants on pain of punishment by the district office and the council.

At Brück (1530) the pastor preached "the long catechism every day" for a fortnight before each of the high feasts (Sehling 1, p. 535).

- **A yearly examination in Lent.** Saxony (1580) prescribed a "yearly examination of the catechism, which shall be held in Lent with the young servants" (Sehling 1, p. 424). Gotha (1555) taught the catechism daily in Lent from Invocavit to Palm Sunday (Sehling 1, p. 569). Pfalz-Neuburg (1576) held the yearly examination "most fitly in Lent, before the ordinary visitation", and told the pastors to use "all gentleness" and be content with "a fair answer" (Sehling 13, p. 177).

House to house. In small places the Saxon pastor examined his people one household at a time. **Electoral Saxony, *Generalia, alle superintendentes belangende*, 1555** (Sehling 1, p. 313):

Also in the market towns where the inhabitants are not too many, the pastor shall take a time in the year for it and summon one house after another before him, and examine in the catechism those that cannot read or are unknown or suspect to the pastors, but especially children and servants, each by himself. So can he afterwards let those that are found fit in such examination come to the Lord's Supper with the better conscience [...] For this shall be kept throughout, that none be admitted to the holy sacrament who cannot pray and cannot give a fair account of the chief articles of Christian doctrine.

What had to be known. The minimum was the text of the chief parts: five in some orders (Ten Commandments, Creed, Our Father, Baptism, the Supper), six where the Office of the Keys was added. The Small Catechism was learned by heart, the Large one read or preached (§15.9.1).

15.11.2 Before first communion

An examination, and often a set course. Every order requires an examination before a child's first communion. Saxony (1580) puts it briefly. **Saxony, *Kirchenordnung*, 1580** (Sehling 1, p. 424):

Fifthly, the pastors shall especially examine with diligence in the catechism those that go for the first time to the holy sacrament of the body and blood of Christ, whether they have learned it, and also inquire carefully whether they are otherwise to be admitted to the communion.

Hohenlohe (1578) gives the clearest answer to "how long". The children of about twelve were taught for an hour a day through Lent. **Hohenlohe, *Kirchenordnung*, 1578** (Sehling 15, p. 277):

Further also all and every pastor in towns and villages shall every year, from Invocavit until Palm Sunday, instruct those children that are about twelve years old and by reason of age are now to receive the holy Supper for the first time, in the holy catechism and the articles of Christian doctrine, every day for an hour, from twelve until one o'clock; and see to it that none be admitted to the Supper who cannot first [say] the six parts of the catechism and have a needful understanding of Christian doctrine.

That is some five or six weeks of daily instruction, on top of years of Sunday catechism and school.

Age. The orders that name an age put first communion at about twelve:

- the Ansbach theologians in 1556 speak of children "of twelve years and above" (Sehling 11, p. 335);
- the Limpurg visitors in 1611 asked whether the pastor "communicates children under twelve years" (Sehling 16, p. 629);
- at Regensburg (1572/1588) children of "eight, nine, ten years" came to confession, and if they lacked understanding the parents were to be told "not to hurry with them" (Sehling 13, p. 510; §15.11.6);
- the Reformed church at Emden admitted children "about fourteen years", after a public profession before the congregation eight days before the Supper (Micron's *Ordinancien*, German edition of 1565, Sehling 7/1, p. 606).

15.11.3 First communion and confirmation

Usually one act. Was first communion separate from confirmation? In most orders that have a confirmation it is the same occasion: the children are examined, confirmed, and admitted to their first communion together. The Hessian form of 1566 (Moderate Reformed) is headed "Questions and answers for the children who are to be confirmed and admitted to communion for the first time" (Sehling 8, p. 300). The heading recurs in the Hessian *Agende* of 1574 (Philippist), Nassau-Weilburg 1576 and Hanau 1609 (Reformed) (Sehling 8, p. 433; 10, pp. 254, 498). Mansfeld held the examination publicly in church the day before. **Mansfeld, *Kirchen-agenda*, 1580** (Sehling 2, p. 233):

Whereas also in our churches this Christian custom hath been kept hitherto, that the children who are to go for the first time to the holy sacrament are publicly examined in the church on the next day before it happeneth, and for this a fixed day is ordained and named every month in every church, and that when they have been examined in the catechism and have passed, they are there confirmed according to the old and laudable use of the church, and the Lord God is called upon and prayed to over them: so we exhort all Christian, God-fearing parents and householders, also schoolmasters and schoolmistresses, that they help to maintain this custom, and at the named time themselves present their children, servants and schoolchildren to the pastors to be examined.

Twice a year at Lauenburg. Saxe-Lauenburg (1585) confirmed twice a year, on the Sunday before Michaelmas and on Quasimodogeniti. The parents first examined the children at home and had their schoolmasters hear them, "that they may give good account … distinctly, with clear voice, without shyness", and then presented them before the altar with the godparents (Sehling 5, pp. 458–459).

A second hearing. Hessen-Kassel (1610, Reformed) required the newly confirmed to repeat their confession half a year later before the second communion. **Hessen-Kassel, *Konsistoriumsordnung*, 1610** (Reformed; Sehling 9, p. 118):

the children, both boys and girls, shall not only, when they are admitted for the first time to the holy Supper and confirmed, first make their confession before the pastor according to all five chief parts of Christian doctrine, but they shall also in the same year, for the better and longer keeping of it, always repeat their confession before the pastor half a year after the confirmation, and thereupon communicate the second time.

Examination without confirmation. Where there was no confirmation rite, as in Electoral Saxony, the examination alone admitted the child to communion (above; Chapter 13, §13.6.7). No order requires a separate course for confirmation apart from the course for first communion. The one instruction served both.

15.11.4 Before marriage

No catechism, no banns. Many orders refused to proclaim or marry the young who did not know the catechism. **Saxony, *Kirchenordnung*, 1580** (Sehling 1, p. 436):

and if they be young folk, [the pastor shall inquire] whether they have also learned their catechism, without knowledge of which they shall not be proclaimed.

The pastor was also to ask "whether they have received the holy sacrament publicly in the church with the congregation of God" (Sehling 1, p. 436). Pfalz-Neuburg (1576) set out the whole interview: kinship, parents' consent, freedom from other promises, and the catechism. **Pfalz-Neuburg, *Generalartikel*, 1576** (Sehling 13, p. 195):

first, whether and how they be related to one another by blood or by marriage; secondly, whether it hath been done with the knowledge and will of the parents and not secretly; thirdly, whether they be both single and not promised to any other; and after this, examine them both out of the catechism, how far they have instruction in it. If now no defect be found in all this, the new married folk shall be blessed without any hindrance according to the church order.

Why the household needed it. Pfalz-Veldenz (1574) gives the reason: the couple would have to teach their own children and servants. **Pfalz-Veldenz, *Kirchenordnung*, 1574** (Sehling 18, p. 529):

The pastors shall also call the new married folk to them before the church-going and require of them an account of their faith and of the doctrine of the catechism. For since they are to keep house and get children and servants, it is profitable indeed, yea, the high necessity and the earnest command of God require it, that they know how to instruct and bring up themselves and them rightly in the confession of Christian doctrine and true religion.

Hesse (1566, Moderate Reformed) has the same rule (Sehling 8, p. 322). The rule was repeated across the later century:

- Mansfeld, by resolution of its ministers, 1580 (Sehling 2, p. 233);
- the Transylvanian synod of Hermannstadt, 1565: if they cannot answer, "one shall delay the copulation until they learn" (Sehling 24, p. 296);
- Prussia, 1568 (Sehling 4, p. 93);
- the Hessian *Reformationsordnung* of 1572 (Philippist): the ignorant were not to be married, nor admitted to communion or to stand godparent, and were to be reported to the authorities (Sehling 8, p. 398);
- Nassau-Diez 1585 (Reformed), Ysenburg-Birstein 1588, Marienhafe 1593 and the Solms discipline order of 1599 (Reformed) (Sehling 10, p. 177; 10, p. 632; 7/1, p. 717; 9, p. 339).

The Reformed Elector Palatine in 1599 and 1608 forbade his officials to accept anyone as a citizen, or let anyone marry, without a pastor's written certificate that they could recite the chief parts (Sehling 19/2, pp. 963–964).

Married on a promise. Where a wedding could not be put off, Wied (1616, Reformed) married the couple on a pledge, backed if need be by sureties. **Wied, *Kirchen- und Polizeiordnung*, 1616** (Reformed; Sehling 19/1, p. 500):

And if for weighty reasons the copulation of young folk about to marry could be put off no longer, then the couple shall promise by giving their hand, and also, if need be, set sureties for it, that they will diligently attend and be found at the catechism sermons until they have well learned and grasped its doctrine.

15.11.5 Premarital instruction and counsel

No counselling course. No order prescribes premarital counselling in the modern sense: a series of meetings on the duties of marriage. What the orders require is three things.

1. An interview some weeks before. The couple, or their parents, came to the pastor in good time. At that meeting the pastor established their freedom to marry and examined their faith. **Limpurg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1610** (Sehling 16, p. 621):

First, the new married folk, or in their stead the parents, guardians or kinsfolk on both sides, shall present themselves before the pastor three weeks before their church-going, or, if one or the other party be absent, bring a written attested certificate from them. And he shall diligently look and inquire whether it be done with the knowledge and will of those in whose power they are, especially the parents, [and] whether there be no hindrance by reason of near kinship or other weighty causes.

In the villages of Brieg (1592) "the bride and bridegroom shall first recite the parts of the catechism to their pastor on a set day" (Sehling 3, p. 447). The Brieg visitation instruction of 1542 had already ordered people to come when the pastor sent for them, "especially when people would enter into the estate of marriage" (Sehling 3, p. 441).

2. Confession and communion before the wedding. Schwäbisch Hall's revised order of 1615 joins the examination to confession. **Schwäbisch Hall, *Kirchenordnung*, 1543, revised text of 1615** (Sehling 17/1, p. 155):

But especially shall new married folk begin, continue and end holy matrimony in the fear of God, to obtain the blessing from God, and also before the wedding betake themselves to confession and thereupon receive absolution and the holy Supper, for the awakening and strengthening of a good purpose to serve God in this estate according to his word, and so to invite Christ to the wedding, who can turn water into wine in matrimony, that is, sorrow into joy. In confession the young new married folk ought rightly to give account, upon the pastor's examination, of the doctrine of the holy catechism.

Freudenthal (1592) required bride and groom to come "together to confession and to God's table before the wedding" (Sehling 3, p. 480).

3. The exhortation and the wedding sermon. The teaching on marriage itself was given publicly, in the exhortation read at the wedding and in the wedding sermon (Chapter 11, §11.4.7). Pfalz-Neuburg allowed the exhortation, "which is in itself a fine short sermon on marriage", to be read "for the instruction and reminding of the new married folk" when there was no time for a sermon (1576, Sehling 13, p. 197). Schwäbisch Hall's pastors were pointed for marriage cases to the handbooks of Hemmingsen, Heshusius, Bidembach, Beust, Porta's *Pastorale Lutheri* (Luther's pastoral) and Sarcerius (1615, Sehling 17/1, p. 155).

15.11.6 Infant communion

No order gives the Supper to infants. Did any order give communion to baptized infants, or argue for it? None does. Every order that speaks of first communion requires instruction and examination first (§15.11.2). Four orders name the communion of

infants outright, and all four set it aside. Their reasons are three:

- the Apostle's command to examine oneself and discern the Lord's body (1 Corinthians 11:28–29), which infants cannot do;
- the judgment of the early church;
- the children of Christians are saved by baptism and faith without the Supper, so to wait does them no harm.

The orders of Hesse (Moderate Reformed) and Hohenlohe (Lutheran) grant that infant communion was the custom in the time of Cyprian and Augustine. Hesse leaves the custom "in its worth" and does not condemn it. The Reformed preacher at Markirch (1561) calls it an error of the ancients.

Hesse: the ancient custom left unjudged. The Hessian order of 1566 (Moderate Reformed) prefaces its rite of confirmation with the history. **Hesse, *Kirchenordnung*, 1566** (Moderate Reformed; Sehling 8, pp. 286–287):

In times past the sacrament of the body and blood of Christ was given to the children to eat and to drink, even as to the old, as soon as they were baptized, as Cyprian testifieth in the sermon *de lapsis* (of the lapsed), and Augustine, as was said before. That we leave in its worth. But we, moved partly by the saying of the apostle, Let a man examine himself, and so let him eat of this bread and drink of this cup, etc., and partly following the common judgment of the first church, defer the giving of the holy Supper to the children unto another time. And we hold it more needful that those who in their infancy, when they could not yet of themselves renounce the devil nor confess the faith of Christ, were cleansed by holy baptism and incorporated into the Lord Christ and his church, should, so soon as the time of their understanding cometh, that they may be instructed in the chief articles of Christian doctrine and religion and are now somewhat taught, then confess their faith before the church and give account of the foremost chief points of the Christian religion […]

Earlier, the same order explains the ancient custom by the early church's joining of baptism and the Supper. The newly baptized "all went straightway to the holy Supper, and so also in the times of holy Augustine it was given to the children, which we yet leave in its worth" (Sehling 8, p. 273).

Oldenburg: infants cannot examine themselves. The Oldenburg order of 1573 argues for infant baptism and, in passing, against infant communion. **Oldenburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1573** (Sehling 7/2.1, p. 1047):

Now one cannot deal with the little children by the bare word alone, for one cannot yet teach them; therefore it must be done through the sacrament, as in the Old Testament through circumcision. But of the Supper of the Lord Paul saith, Let a man examine himself; and again, he shall discern the Lord's body, 1 Cor. 11; which the young little children cannot yet do.

Hohenlohe: children saved without the Supper. Hohenlohe in 1578 answered those who held the Supper needless to the baptized believer. **Hohenlohe, *Kirchenordnung*, 1578** (Sehling 15, p. 334):

Moreover, it is true that the children of Christians are saved through faith and baptism, without the use of the Supper, as Christ saith, He that believeth and is baptized shall be saved. Although in the time of Augustine it was the custom that the young children were given to drink of the cup of the Lord, yet it followeth not hereof that the grown need not the holy Supper, and that the baptism and faith they have received are enough for them.

Markirch: an error of the ancients. Arnaud Banc, preacher of the Reformed French congregation in the Leber valley at Markirch, in the lordship of Rappoltstein, explained in 1561 why his church would not carry the Supper to the sick. Private communion, he wrote, rested on a false belief. **Rappoltstein, Arnaud Banc's report on the doctrine of the French congregation, 1561** (Reformed; Sehling 20/2, p. 142):

This pertaineth to the opinion and belief of those who suppose that all persons who had not received the Supper are lost; wherein the ancients also erred, who for that cause gave the Supper to the little children.

Instruction first. Other orders reach the same practice without naming the ancient custom. Brenz at Schwäbisch Hall in 1527 drew the line from the catechumenate of the early church. **Schwäbisch Hall, *Ordnung der Gottesdienste an Werk- und Feiertagen*, 1527** (Sehling 17/1, p. 66):

This also was the custom in the church newly risen, that none was admitted to baptism but he that had first been a catechumen. Now, since we are baptized as children, we must be instructed in the things of faith before we be admitted to the communion of the Lord's Supper.

The Limpurg visitors' question of 1611, whether the pastor "communicates children under twelve years" (§15.11.2), presumes the same rule.

No harm to the child who waits. An order that deferred the Supper had to say what became of a child who died before first communion. Regensburg told the confessors to warn parents not to hurry children of eight, nine or ten years who lacked understanding. **Regensburg, *Kirchenregimentsordnung*, 1572/1588** (Sehling 13, p. 510):

because to this sacrament belongeth a special understanding and trial; and that it is no hurt to their salvation, if they be otherwise well brought up; as also such children, if God should call them out of this life before they come to the communion, shall at their parents' desire be laid in the earth with the accustomed procession and ceremonies, as well as other grown persons, according to the order of government.

Henneberg abolished a custom of burying such children apart. **Henneberg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1582** (Sehling 2, p. 316):

And whereas in some places the custom hath hitherto been kept that the little children which had not yet received the Supper of Christ were not laid in the earth with the scholars, as the old are, henceforth no difference shall be made herein, but the children shall be brought to burial with the ceremonies set down above, no less than the old.

The sick child. The one exception to the order of instruction, confirmation and communion was the child in danger of death. Nassau-Dillenburg (1575, Philippist) kept the unconfirmed from the sacrament, but not a dying child who understood the catechism and asked for it. **Nassau-Dillenburg, *Agende*, 1575** (Philippist; Sehling 10, p. 155):

Those children that have not yet in such wise been heard and confirmed shall be kept from the sacrament, until they be received by confirmation. Yet if any among the children be sick, and the weakness seem somewhat dangerous, and the child be fairly understanding and grounded in the catechism, and desire the Supper, it shall in no wise be denied it, notwithstanding that it hath not yet received confirmation. But such a child shall none the less bind itself to present itself for confirmation when it hath recovered its health.

15.12 Table by order

How to read the table. The table lists the orders that give the fullest provisions on each question, in date order. Section numbers refer to this chapter.

Order	Vol.	Provisions (§)
Schwäbisch Hall, 1527	17/1	baptized as children, so instructed before communion (15.11.6)
Belzig and the Saxon visitations, 1529	1	quarterly catechism series, a fortnight each, enforced by penalties (15.11.1)
Brück, 1530	1	daily catechism sermons before the high feasts; girls under eleven taught catechism (15.9.3, 15.11.1)
Brandenburg-Nürnberg, 1533	11	householders to bring children and servants to sermon and sacrament (15.8.2)
Esslingen, 1534 (Moderate Reformed)	17/2	ten articles for the German schoolmaster; catechism as primer (15.9.1)
Augsburg, 1537 (Moderate Reformed)	12	superattendent and bishop "one thing"; rotating oversight (15.4.1)
Hesse, *Stipendiatenordnung*, 1546 (Moderate Reformed)	8	stipendiaries examined twice a year before all theology professors (15.6)
Nassau-Dillenburg synod, 1552	10	*loci* set from synod to synod; pastors to buy books (15.7.5)
Mecklenburg, 1552	5	magistrate keeper of both tables (15.10.1)
Electoral Saxony, *Generalia*, 1555	1	superintendents' visitation and synod; weeks of instruction at Wittenberg; practice sermons; house-to-house examination; deacons' duties (15.3.5, 15.4.2, 15.7.2, 15.7.3, 15.11.1)

Order	Vol.	Provisions (§)
Electoral Saxony, *General-Artikel*, 1557	1	pastors' reading list and conduct; superintendent's synod; ordination examination and public sermon (15.3.2, 15.3.3, 15.4.2, 15.7.3)
Württemberg, 1559	16, 17/1	Tübingen *Stipendium*: practice sermons corrected; visitation of the minister's household (15.3.3, 15.7.1, 15.7.2)
Markirch (Rappoltstein), 1561 (Reformed)	20/2	infant communion an error of the ancients (15.11.6)
Weimar, 1561; Jena, 1569	1	prince as supreme president; superintendent as president of the consistory (15.5.1, 15.5.2)
Palatinate, *Kirchenratsordnung*, 1564; report, 1571 (Reformed)	14	trial sermon; new men to serve first as deacons; monthly convents with sermon criticism (7.3–7.5)
Hesse, 1566 (Moderate Reformed)	8	candidates kept at Marburg for lectures; sextons held to ministers' conduct; confirmation and first communion together; infant communion deferred; catechism before marriage (15.7.3, 15.8.4, 15.11.3, 15.11.4, 15.11.6)
Lasseln (Transylvania), 1572; Mediasch synod, 1572	24	elected deans; magistrate nourisher of churches and schools (15.4.4, 15.10.1)
Regensburg, 1572/1588	13	children of eight to ten not hurried to communion; buried like adults if they die first (15.11.2, 15.11.6)
Oldenburg, 1573	7/2.1	infants cannot examine themselves (15.11.6)
Pfalz-Veldenz, 1574	18	catechism before marriage, for the household's sake (15.11.4)
Nassau-Dillenburg, *Agende*, 1575 (Philippist)	10	sick child communicated before confirmation (15.11.6)
Nassau-Weilburg, 1576	10	absentees counted house by house and fined; registers of confirmations (15.3.4, 15.8.1)
Pfalz-Neuburg, 1576	13	four-point examination before marriage; consistory book of candidates (15.7.4, 15.11.4)
Hohenlohe, 1578; 1588	15	daily hour of instruction in Lent before first communion at about twelve; communion once or twice a year; children saved without the Supper (15.8.1, 15.11.2, 15.11.6)
Saxony, 1580	1	parish registers; consistory composition and business; German schoolmasters at sermon; first communicants examined; no banns without the catechism (15.3.4, 15.5.2, 15.5.3, 15.9.2, 15.11.2, 15.11.4)
Mansfeld, 1580	2	monthly public examination and confirmation before first communion; no marriage without the catechism (15.11.3, 15.11.4)
Hoya, 1581	6/2	residence and leave; books bought by the parish; ministers and sextons out of taverns (15.3.2, 15.3.4, 15.8.4)
Henneberg, 1582	2	uncommunicated children buried like adults (15.11.6)
Dillenburg synod, 1582 (Reformed)	10	domestic visitation; prayer at home morning, evening and at meals (15.8.2)
Lauenburg, 1585	5	confirmation twice a year, with parents and godparents (15.11.3)
Regensburg, 1588	13	lay president of the consistory (15.5.2)
Strasbourg, 1598	20/1	pastor's office in one visitation article (15.3.1)

Order	Vol.	Provisions (§)
Grubenhagen, 1600	6/2	superintendent's sworn instruction (15.4.3)
Palatinate mandates, 1599, 1607, 1608 (Reformed)	19/2	new deacons' sermon outlines censured; no citizenship or marriage without the catechism (15.7.4, 15.11.4)
Hanau, 1609, 1612; Ysenburg-Birstein, 1608 (all Reformed)	10	magistrate over bodies, not souls; weekly consistory sessions (15.5.2, 15.5.3, 15.10.3)
Limpurg, 1610	16	couple to come three weeks before the wedding (15.11.5)
Hessen-Kassel, 1610 (Reformed)	9	confession repeated half a year after confirmation (15.11.3)
Schwäbisch Hall, 1615 revision	17/1	confession and communion before the wedding; catechism examined in confession (15.11.5)
Wied, 1616 (Reformed)	19/1	marriage on a pledge, with sureties, to attend catechism (15.11.4)

15.13 Concordance of the orders quoted

The concordance. Every order quoted in this chapter is listed below, with the volume and pages of Sehling, the `eko.db` document that holds the text, and the sections where it is quoted. Orders cited only in summary can be found through the table in §15.12 and the text.

Order	Sehling	Doc	Quoted in §
Augsburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1537 (Moderate Reformed)	12, p. 55	338	15.4.1
Belzig, *Ordnung der Stadt Belzig*, 1529	1, p. 527	63	15.11.1
Brandenburg-Nürnberg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1533	11, p. 188	270	15.8.2
Electoral Saxony, *Generalia, alle superintendentes belangende*, 1555	1, pp. 313, 314, 315	36	15.3.5, 15.7.2, 15.11.1
Electoral Saxony, *General-Artikel und gemeiner Bericht*, 1557	1, pp. 320–321, 322	37	15.3.2, 15.3.3, 15.4.2, 15.7.3
Esslingen, *Artikel für den deutschen Schulmeister*, [1534] (Moderate Reformed)	17/2, p. 381	881	15.9.1
Grubenhagen, *Officium superintendentis Grubenhagici*, 1600	6/2, p. 1109	2058	15.4.3
Hanau-Münzenberg, *Presbyteriumsordnung*, [1609] (Reformed)	10, p. 512	211	15.10.3
Henneberg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1582	2, p. 316	1247	15.11.6
Hesse, *Stipendiatenordnung*, 1546 (Moderate Reformed)	8, p. 159	2255	15.6
Hesse, *Kirchenordnung*, 1566 (Moderate Reformed)	8, pp. 201, 211, 286–287	2257	15.7.3, 15.8.4, 15.11.6
Hessen-Kassel, *Konsistoriumsordnung*, 1610 (Reformed)	9, p. 118	2287	15.11.3
Hohenlohe, *Kirchenordnung*, 1578	15, pp. 277, 334	574	15.11.2, 15.11.6
Hohenlohe, *Polizei- und Rügordnung*, 1588	15, p. 594	613	15.8.1
Hoya, *Kirchenordnung*, 1581	6/2, p. 1140	2065	15.3.4
Limpurg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1610	16, p. 621	729	15.11.5
Lüneburg, *Instruktion zu den Visitationen*, 1565	6/1, p. 576	2006	15.10.2
Mansfeld, *Kirchen-agenda*, 1580	2, p. 233	1241	15.11.3

Order	Sehling	Doc	Quoted in §
Mecklenburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1552	5, p. 189	1922	15.10.1
Nassau-Dillenburg, *Synodalabschied*, 1552	10, p. 93	172	15.7.5
Nassau-Dillenburg, *Agende*, 1575 (Philippist)	10, p. 155	182	15.11.6
Nassau-Dillenburg, *Abschied der Dillenburger Generalsynode*, 1582 (Reformed)	10, p. 173	186	15.8.2
Nassau-Weilburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1576	10, p. 309	198	15.8.1
Oldenburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1573	7/2.1, p. 1047	2148	15.11.6
Palatinate, *Mandat zu den Konventen, der Predigtaufsicht und den Diakonen*, 1607 (Reformed)	19/2, p. 957	1195	15.7.4
Palatinate, *Kirchenratsordnung*, 1564 (Reformed)	14, p. 413	504	15.7.4
Palatinate, Wenzel Zuleger's report on the classical convents, [1571] (Reformed)	14, p. 446	504	15.7.5
Pfalz-Neuburg, *Generalartikel*, 1576	13, p. 195	404	15.11.4
Pfalz-Veldenz, *Kirchenordnung*, 1574	18, p. 529	1011	15.11.4
Rappoltstein, Arnaud Banc's report on the doctrine of the French congregation, 1561 (Reformed)	20/2, p. 142	1371	15.11.6
Regensburg, *Kirchenregimentsordnung*, 1572/1588	13, p. 510	452	15.11.6
Regensburg, *Ordnung des consistorii*, 1588	13, pp. 513–514	453	15.5.2
Saxe-Weimar, *Ordnung und reformation ecclesiastici consistorii zu Jena*, 1569	1, p. 234	24	15.5.1
Saxony, *Kirchenordnung*, 1580	1, pp. 370, 397, 403, 424, 436	44	15.3.4, 15.5.3, 15.9.2, 15.11.2, 15.11.4
Schwäbisch Hall, *Ordnung der Gottesdienste an Werk- und Feiertagen*, 1527	17/1, p. 66	756	15.11.6
Schwäbisch Hall, *Kirchenordnung*, 1543, revised text of 1615	17/1, p. 155	762	15.11.5
Strasbourg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1598	20/1, p. 689	1344	15.3.1
Transylvania, Statutes of the Chapter of Lasseln, 1572	24, p. 361	1692	15.4.4
Transylvania, *Bekenntnisformel der Mediascher Synode*, 1572	24, p. 349	1691	15.10.1
Wied, *Kirchen- und Polizeiordnung*, 1616 (Reformed)	19/1, p. 500	1100	15.11.4
Württemberg, *Ordnung des Tübinger Stipendiums*, 1559	17/1, p. 561	813	15.7.2

Chapter 16. Minor Orders, Deacons and Elders

This chapter covers what became of the medieval grades and liturgical offices below the priesthood in the evangelical church orders printed in Emil Sehling's *Die evangelischen Kirchenordnungen des XVI. Jahrhunderts* (The Evangelical Church Orders of the Sixteenth Century). It also covers the new offices that took their place. It asks ten questions:

- Were any of the **minor orders** (porter, lector, exorcist, acolyte) or the **subdiaconate** kept as formal orders?
- Do the orders mention or prescribe the **liturgical roles**: lector, thurifer, candle-bearer (*accensor*, *ceroferarius* [candle-bearer]), cross-bearer, torch-bearer, boat-bearer and master of ceremonies? This is asked whether or not a formal order stood behind the role.
- Where was the **diaconate** kept? Was it kept as an order below the presbyterate, as a liturgical role at the altar, or as a lay office for the poor?
- Where it was kept, was it held to be a separate order **by divine right**, or only **by human right**? Were there **lay deacons**?
- Did any order have **lay elders** or **ruling elders**? Were they **ordained**?
- What did each of these offices do, and what were they forbidden to do?
- Which offices were **abolished** or **forbidden**?
- On what **grounds** were the offices kept, created or abolished?
- What became of the **sacristan**, of lay **care of the altar**, of **deaconesses**, and of **monks**, **nuns**, **tertiaries** and other members of religious communities? How were they received or installed?
- What might **women**, and **laymen** who were not ministers, do in the church's services? Could women be elders, churchwardens or lay deacons, hold a lesser office, read or lead the prayers, be cantors, or sing in or direct the choir? Could laymen give the bread and the cup, lead the prayers, or read the bids?

The findings are summarised in §16.1, and §16.2 explains the method and the words that most often mislead. §16.3 deals with the minor orders and the subdiaconate, and §16.4 with the liturgical roles. §16.5 covers the diaconate in its three forms and the question of divine or human right. §16.6 covers elders. §16.7 covers sacristans, altar care, deaconesses, monks, nuns, tertiaries and confraternities. §16.8 gathers how each office was installed, and whether it was ordained. §16.9 asks what women and laymen might do in the church's services. §16.10 is a table by order, and §16.11 a concordance of every order quoted.

Related chapters. Several subjects are treated more fully elsewhere and are only cited here:

- the installation rites, with the full forms: Chapter 13, §§13.10–13.12;
- the duties of pastors and deacons, church workers and schoolmasters: Chapter 15, §§15.3, 15.8.4, 15.9;
- the oaths and promises of ministers and church officers: Chapter 17, §17.4;
- places at the altar in the ceremonial of the Mass: Chapter 2, §2.15.8;
- vestments and clerical dress: Chapter 14, §§14.7–14.8;
- the offices kept in the convents: Chapter 10, §§10.4.4, 10.6.3.

16.1 Summary of findings

1. The minor orders were not kept as orders anywhere in the German church orders. No order in the corpus ordains a porter, lector, exorcist or acolyte, nor a subdeacon in the medieval sense. Their disappearance is mostly silent. Where it is argued, the grounds are three:

- They have no warrant in Scripture. Homberg 1526 (Moderate Reformed) says "Scripture knows no other ministers than bishops, that is presbyters, and deacons of the poor" (§16.3.2).
- They were later human additions to the apostolic diaconate. The Strasbourg examination order of about 1539 (Moderate Reformed) gives a short history of the grades (§16.3.1).
- They belong with the tonsure, the "platten", and other merely human ordinances. Freiberg 1537 and Brunswick 1528 say so (§16.3.3).

The one exception lies outside the Lutheran and Reformed territorial churches. The *Ordo ecclesiasticus* (Church Order) of the Bohemian Brethren (Hussite), printed among the Polish orders, keeps the **acolyte** as the first ordained grade, under the deacon (§16.3.4). The young men are received before the synod with a handshake, a promise and a blessing.

2. The functions of the minor orders survived without the orders.

- *Porter:* the porter's keys passed to the **sexton** (*Opfermann*, *Küster*). Hesse 1566 (Moderate Reformed) calls him the *ianitor* (doorkeeper) of the Old Testament and the *aedituus* or *custos* of today (§16.3.5).
- *Lector:* reading passed to the **schoolboys**, who read the epistle at Vespers (Rostock 1560), and to the **deacon**, the assistant minister.
- *Exorcist:* the office disappeared altogether. Strasbourg (1539, Moderate Reformed) says exorcism was "rather a singular gift than a common function".

3. The liturgical roles were rarely prescribed and soon dropped.

- **Ministrants:** in the 1520s–1540s some Mass-shaped orders still have ministrants (*Ministranten*) at the altar. Examples are Nürnberg 1524 and Brandenburg 1540, the latter "in deacons' dalmatics" where there are enough clergy. In Pfalz-Neuburg 1543, "where there are ministrants", the subdeacon reads the epistle and the deacon the gospel and gives the cup (§16.4.1–16.4.2).
- **Levites:** Regensburg 1542 kept a full **levitical service**, with a priest celebrant and two "levites", a gospeller and an epistoler. Regensburg abolished the levites and their vestments in 1554, and again in its church order of 1567. Brandenburg-Ansbach's chapter order of 1565/78 forbade "levites after the papistical use" (§16.4.3).
- **Thurifer:** Luther left incense free in 1523, "we neither forbid it nor require it". Incense then disappears from the rubrics (§16.4.4).
- **Cross:** a **cross** is carried in a rogation procession at Stendal (1541) and before the coffin at funerals in many orders (Brandenburg 1540, Waldeck 1556, Anhalt, Prenzlau 1557). The bearer is a schoolboy or the sexton. Schwäbisch Hall (1615) allows it "significatively, not effectively" (§16.4.5).
- **Not found:** the corpus holds no candle-bearer (*accensor*, *ceroferarius* [candle-bearer]), torch-bearer, boat-bearer or master of ceremonies as a prescribed role. Lights might still be carried at Brandenburg funerals and before the sacrament in Baden 1533, by bearers the orders do not name.

4. The diaconate survived in three distinct forms, which the same word hides:

- **The Lutheran *Diaconus*.** This is the second or third minister of a town church: a *Helfer* (assistant), *Kaplan* (chaplain) or *Capellan* (chaplain). He is a full minister of the word and sacraments, **ordained with the same rite as a pastor**, and usually a step on the way to a pastorate. Electoral Saxony 1580 allows a gifted man to become a pastor "without passing through the diaconate" (§16.5.1). Württemberg and Saxony also have a *Subdiaconus*, a third minister. These are grades of benefice and seniority, not separate orders.
- **The liturgical deacon and subdeacon at the altar.** These occur in a few early orders and are normally priests acting as levites (§16.4.2).
- **The lay deacon of the poor.** This office was built on Acts 6 and 1 Timothy 3:
  - In **Bugenhagen's** orders the treasury and alms deacons (*diakene*) are honest laymen who handle the common chest and visit no one with the word. Brunswick 1528 says they serve as Stephen and Lawrence did, "without tonsure and without deacon's coat" (§16.3.3, §16.5.2). The same office appears in Hamburg 1529, Lübeck 1531, Pomerania, and the Lutheran Dutch congregation at Frankfurt (1585).
  - Elsewhere they are called *leviten* (levites; Hadeln 1526), *subdiaconi oder bittherren* (subdeacons or bidding-men; Naumburg 1537), or *diaconi ecclesiae et pauperum* (deacons of the church and of the poor). In Pomerania 1574 the *diaconi ecclesiae et pauperum* are bound by oath; in Pyritz 1539, by express decision, by no oath.
  - In **Hesse 1566** (Moderate Reformed) and the **Reformed** churches (Micron 1554/65, Kurpfalz, Nassau, Bentheim) the deacons of the poor are one of the four offices. They are elected, examined, and in Hesse and Micron **ordained with laying on of hands** (§16.5.3).

5. Divine or human right. No church order sets the deacon as a separate order *by divine right* above the people and below the presbyter in the Roman sense. The positions are these:

- **One ministry of the word by divine right; grades by human right.**
  - Bugenhagen writes "bishops or preachers (which is all one thing)".
  - Pfalz-Zweibrücken 1539 speaks of "the nearest bishops, whom men also call pastors".
  - Melanchthon's *Wittenberg Reformation* (1545) puts bishops "as a grade above other priests" on grounds of "human foresight".
  - The Lutheran diaconate falls under this rule. It is one ministry, graded for order's sake (§16.5.4).
- **The lay deacon of the poor as an apostolic institution.**

- Homberg 1526 (Moderate Reformed) says Scripture knows "deacons of the poor".
- Strasbourg (1539, Moderate Reformed) says the diaconate was instituted "by the Holy Ghost through the Apostles", the subdiaconate and the rest only "afterwards".
- Hesse 1566 (Moderate Reformed) cites Acts 6, and so do the Reformed orders. The editors of the Hildesheim volume read Bugenhagen's ranking of poor relief among "divine ordinances" as making the deacon's office one of divine right (Sehling 7/2.1, p. 811).
- The Bohemian Brethren (Hussite) keep the diaconate as a grade which "it is not fitting to cast out of the church", though "the Antichrist drew it into abuse".

6. Lay elders existed, chiefly in the Bucerian and Reformed orders, and were often ordained.

- **Strasbourg (about 1539)** (Moderate Reformed) teaches two "orders of presbyters": those who administer word and sacraments, and those "employed only for the discipline of the church". Its churchwardens (*Kirchenpfleger*) of 1553, in Marbach's Lutheran order, are these *seniores* and *presbyteri* (§16.6.1).
- **Hesse (1539, 1566)** (Moderate Reformed) has the elders elected by the ministers and congregation and confirmed with prayer. In 1566 they are **"ordained" with laying on of hands** under Acts 14:23. Elders also lay hands on new ministers at their ordination (§16.6.2).
- **The Reformed orders** have elected elders who govern with the ministers, exercise discipline (Matthew 18) and oversee the ministers' doctrine and life. The installation forms differ:
  - laying on of hands: Micron 1554/65 and Kurpfalz 1592 (both Reformed);
  - prayer and commendation only: Pfalz-Veldenz 1574;
  - handfast vow and public prayer: Kurpfalz about 1601 and Hanau 1609 (both Reformed);
  - a sworn oath: Solms 1594 (Reformed; §16.6.3).
- **The Bohemian Brethren** (Hussite) elect lay "political presbyters" (*presbyteri politici*), and female *presbyterae* for the women. These bind themselves by voice and handshake but receive no laying on of hands (§16.6.4).

7. In the Lutheran orders "elder" is usually not an office of governance.

- The *Kirchenväter* (churchwardens), *Kirchgeschworene*, *Kastenherren* (chest-wardens) and *Kirchenpfleger* are lay stewards of church goods and alms.
- Memmingen (1532, Moderate Reformed) gives its churchwardens "no temporal jurisdiction", "so that two temporal authorities arise not again in our city" (§16.6.5).
- *Seniores* in Ansbach, Pomerania and Silesia are senior **clergy** of a chapter or synod.

8. What the offices could not do.

- Lay deacons and lay elders did not preach or administer the sacraments.
- In the Bohemian order even the ordained deacon might distribute the bread and the cup, but only a minister "having the power of the keys" might pronounce absolution and recite the words of institution (§16.5.3).
- Reformed elders had spiritual discipline but no civil punishment. In the Reformed Kurpfalz the advocates of presbyteries pleaded their divine right against Erastus. By the editors' account the dispute was settled in 1569 by opinions of Beza, Ursinus and Zanchi, and in 1570 an edict set up church discipline (Sehling 14, p. 53; §16.6.3).

9. Sacristans, altar care, deaconesses and the religious.

- **Sacristans.** No order has a sacristan distinct from the sexton. The *Küster*, *Custos*, *Mesner* (sexton) or *Sigrist* (sexton) kept the chalices, vestments and font, prepared the altar, vested the pastor and went with him to the sick. Anhalt (1594, Philippist) and Sayn (1590) spell out the duties; Heilbronn (1543) forbids women to serve at the font (§16.7.1).
- **Altar guild.** None exists in the corpus. The altar was kept by the sexton and the lay churchwardens or deacons. Pomerania (1574) charges the *diaconi* (deacons) with "the altar with its ornament". The confraternities and Kalands that had kept altars and lights were dissolved into the common chest from Leisnig (1523) onward (§16.7.2).
- **Deaconesses.** There is no order of deaconesses. The word *diaconissa* (deaconess) appears once, for the almoner of the convent of Keppel (1570). The nearest equivalents are the Bohemian *presbyterae* and the *Seelfrauen* (soul-women) and beguines appointed to nurse the sick under the pastor (Regensburg 1543, Nördlingen 1544, Heilbronn 1531) (§16.7.3).
- **Monks.** New professions ended everywhere. Monks might leave and marry with a settlement or stay with maintenance. A few abbeys (Herrenalb, Ravengiersburg) were kept as evangelical schools for the ministry under an evangelical abbot or prior, without vows (§16.7.4).

- **Nuns.** Many women's houses survived as evangelical convents. Admission was put under the prince or council; the vows were declared not binding; the consecrated habit was abolished or made optional, "for all Christians alike are clothed in baptism" (Mecklenburg 1572). Keppel (1570) prints a full evangelical rite of clothing with an oath, and elected *dominae*, abbesses and prioresses swore oaths of office (§16.7.5).
- **Tertiaries and confraternities.** Beguine and Lollard houses were closed to new members. Heilbronn turned its beguines into visitors of the sick. Herford counted the separate houses of the Brethren and Sisters of the Common Life among "factions and sects". No order kept or founded a third order (§16.7.6).

10. Women in the church's services (§16.9).

- **Kept from the ministry and its parts.** The orders read 1 Corinthians 14:34 and 1 Timothy 2:12 broadly. Hesse in 1566 (Moderate Reformed) and the orders that copied it forbade women "all the actions of the church's service". Homberg 1526 (Moderate Reformed) let them attend the congregation's assembly, but not speak in it.
- **No elder, churchwarden, deacon of the poor or sexton was a woman**, the Bohemian women elders (*presbyterae*) excepted (§16.6.4). The one parish office open to women was that of the girls' schoolmistress. The midwife was sworn because she might have to baptize.
- **In the convents** the sisters read the lessons, led the prayers by weekly turns, and had their own precentress (*cantrix*), sacristaness and almoner.
- **Singing.** Women sang with the congregation, and were told to. In some towns the schoolgirls sang as a choir of their own, led by men (Naumburg 1537/38, Hof 1592); Zwickau abolished one in 1529.

11. Laymen in the church's services (§16.9).

- **The bread and the cup** were the ministers'. Hesse (1566, Moderate Reformed) let a senior, a keeper of the chest, a schoolmaster or the sexton help with the cup when there were many communicants. Nassau-Weilburg forbade lay ministers of the cup in 1617. Micron's Reformed communicants passed the bread and the cups to one another along the table.
- **Prayer.** Schoolboys, schoolmasters and sextons sang the Litany. In filial churches the sexton read the epistle, the gospel and the catechism, and he might close with a collect in the pastor's absence. But he might not preach unless examined and ordained (Electoral Saxony 1557).
- **The bids** of the general prayer were read by the pastor, the deacon or the chaplain. Laypeople asked for prayers, by word or by slips laid on the pulpit.

16.2 Scope, sources and the words that mislead

Sources. The `eko.db` database was searched for the names of every grade and role in question, in German, Low German and Latin spellings. The searches covered:

- *ostiarius* (doorkeeper), *Türhüter* (doorkeeper), *ianitor* (doorkeeper);
- *lector* (reader), *Leser* (reader);
- *exorcista*, *Beschwörer* (exorcist);
- *acoluthus* (acolyte), *Akolyth* (acolyte);
- *subdiaconus* (subdeacon), *Unterdiakon* (subdeacon);
- *ministrant*, *Levit* (levite), *Evangelier* (gospeller), *Epistler* (epistoler);
- *thuribulum* (thurible), *Rauchfass* (censer), *Weihrauch* (incense), *navicula* (incense boat), *Schiffchen* (incense boat);
- *ceroferarius* (candle-bearer), *Kerzenträger* (candle-bearer), *Fackel* (torch), *Leuchter* (candlestick);
- *crucifer* (cross-bearer), *Kreuz vortragen* (carry the cross before), *Kreuzträger* (cross-bearer);
- *ceremoniarius* (master of ceremonies), *magister caerimoniarum* (master of ceremonies);
- *Diaconus* (deacon), *Diakon* (deacon), *diaken* (deacon), *Helfer* (assistant), *Kaplan* (chaplain);
- *Eltesten* (elders), *Senior*, *Presbyter*, *Kirchenpfleger* (churchwardens), *Kirchenälteste* (church elders), *Censor*;
- for §16.7: *Sakristei* (sacristy), *Sigrist* (sexton), *Mesner* (sexton), *Küster* (sexton), *Custos*, *Glöckner* (bell-ringer); *Oblaten* (wafers), *Altartuch* (altar cloth), *Bruderschaft* (confraternity), *Kaland* (Kaland brotherhood); *diaconissa* (deaconess), *Seelfrau* (soul-woman), *Seelnonne* (soul-nun), *Krankenwärterin* (sick-nurse); *Kloster* (monastery), *Novize* (novice), *Profess* (profession), *Gelübde* (vow), *einkleiden* (clothe), *Kappe* (cowl), *Weihel* (veil), *Domina* (prioress), *Äbtissin* (abbess), *Priorin* (prioress); *Begine* (beguine), *Nollhart* (Lollard), *Fraterhaus* (brethren-house), *Terziarin* (tertiary);

- for §16.9: the words for women, maidens, girls, widows and matrons, with *mulier*, *puella* and *matrona*; the feminine titles of office (schoolmistress, sextoness, *custorin*, *cantrix*, precentress, reader); and, for laymen, the giving of the cup, the Litany, the reader, the intercession and the slip laid on the pulpit.

The registers of the edition were used to find further passages. The passages were then read in context.

The corpus is very uneven on these matters:

- The **Lutheran** orders say almost nothing about the minor orders. They simply stopped ordaining them, and the Mass rubrics assume a pastor, a deacon (assistant minister), a sexton and a school choir.
- The **Bucerian, Hessian and Reformed** orders (Strasbourg and Hesse, Moderate Reformed; East Frisia, Kurpfalz, Nassau and the Wetterau counties, Reformed) say a great deal about elders and deacons. They argue for them from Scripture and the early Church.
- The **Bohemian Brethren's** *Ordo ecclesiasticus* (Church Order; Hussite), printed in Sehling's Polish volume (vol. 4), is the only order in the corpus with a graded clergy below the presbyter.

Words that mislead. The same word often names quite different offices:

Word	Usual meaning in the corpus	Also used for
Diaconus, *Diacon* (deacon), *Helfer*, *Kaplan*	In Lutheran towns, the second or third **ordained minister** of a parish (§16.5.1)	The **lay deacon of the poor** (Bugenhagen; Hesse, Moderate Reformed; the Reformed churches; §16.5.2–16.5.3); the **ministrant at the altar** in a few early Mass orders (§16.4.2)
Subdiaconus, *Unterdiacon*	In Saxony, Württemberg and Halle, the **third minister** of a town church (§16.3.3)	Naumburg 1537: a **lay alms-collector** (*bittherr*, §16.5.2); Pfalz-Neuburg 1543: the **epistoler** at Mass (§16.4.2)
Levit, *Leviten* (levites)	In Regensburg and Nürnberg, the **two assisting clergy** (gospeller and epistoler) at Mass (§16.4.3)	Hadeln 1526: the **lay deacons of the poor** (§16.5.2)
Eltesten, *Seniores*, *Presbyteri*	In Hesse (Moderate Reformed) and the Reformed orders, **lay governing elders** (§16.6.2–16.6.3)	Also the **ministers of the word**, the "elders who labour in the word" (Hesse 1566, Moderate Reformed; Micron and Kurpfalz 1592, Reformed); in Ansbach, Pomerania and Silesia, the **senior clergy** of a chapter or synod (§16.6.5)
Kirchenpfleger, *Kirchenväter* (churchwardens), *Kastenherren* (chest-wardens)	In most Lutheran orders, **lay stewards** of church goods (§16.6.5)	Strasbourg 1553 (Lutheran): the **disciplinary elders**, "whom they named *seniores* and *presbyteri*" (§16.6.1)
Ordinieren	The ordination of a **minister of the word**	Hesse 1566 (Moderate Reformed), Lippe 1538 and Pfalz-Veldenz 1574 also use it of **elders** and **deacons**. In Lippe it means simply to "appoint" deacons

Two consequences follow:

- A list of the *Diaconi* (deacons) of a Saxon or Württemberg town is a list of **clergy**. A list of the *diakene* (deacons) of Brunswick or Hamburg is a list of **laymen**.
- "Elder" in a Lutheran church order usually means a churchwarden or a senior pastor, not a governing elder in the Reformed sense.

Not covered. The following are outside the scope of this chapter, except where they explain an office:

- Schoolmasters, cantors and organists, except where they led the prayers or the singing (§16.9). (Hamburg 1529 lists the sexton and the organists among the church servants, and the **midwives** "may well be called church servants" too.)
- Visitors and superintendents.

- Consistories.

16.3 The minor orders and the subdiaconate

No evangelical church order in the corpus ordains porters, lectors, exorcists or acolytes, nor a subdeacon in the medieval sense of a major order. No order forbids them by name either: the minor orders are not abolished by statute but simply left out of the new ordination rites, which know only the one ministry of the word. Three passages give reasons for this. One order, that of the Bohemian Brethren, keeps the acolyte as a grade of its own.

16.3.1 Strasbourg: a short history of the grades

The Strasbourg examination order for candidates for the ministry (1539, Moderate Reformed) asks the candidate to account for the grades of the clergy. Its answers are the fullest statement in the corpus of how the reformers viewed them:

- There are two "orders of presbyters": those who preach and administer the sacraments, and the lay *seniores* "employed only for the discipline of the church" (on these see §16.6.1).
- The diaconate alone was instituted "by the Holy Ghost through the Apostles".
- The subdeacons, archdeacons, lectors, acolytes and porters were added "afterwards" as helpers to the deacons.
- The exorcist's work was a charism, not an office.

Strasbourg, *Examensordnung*, Latin version, after 9 September 1539, questions 93–95 (Moderate Reformed; Sehling 20/1, p. 310):

93. How many are the orders of presbyters? Answer: Two. The one, of them which administer the Gospel and the Sacraments, together with discipline, of whom Paul the apostle giveth charge, 1 Timothy 3[:1–7] and Titus 1[:7–9], who also are called Bishops by the Apostle. The other, of them which are employed only for the discipline of the church; such elders as of old the Synagogue had, so afterward the church also had, without whose counsel nothing was done in the church. […] 94. What other holy orders of the clergy hath the church? Answer: By the first institution of the Holy Ghost, delivered through the Apostles, the church hath Deacons. Afterward were set under these the subdeacons, and archdeacons set over them, whose office was to take charge of and dispense the common offerings and alms of the faithful, and in the keeping of the discipline of the church and in the other ministries of the church to serve and minister unto the presbyters; wherefore they were called Deacons, that is, ministers. There were added also lectors, which recited the holy books in the church; and Acolytes, which followed the presbyters for the sake of witness and of ministry; and porters, which kept the unworthy from the holy assemblies. For the office of the Exorcists was rather of a singular gift than of a common function, such as belongeth properly and always to the holy ministry. 95. How many are the ministries of the church which are necessary, which it behoveth to have even today? Answer: Three: the Ministry of the pastoral office, that of the care of the poor, and that of the School for the instructing of the youth of the church.

The same order gives the place once held by the deacons and subdeacons to the **schoolmasters**. They are to be "second from the order of priests". **Strasbourg, *Examensordnung*, Latin version, 1539** (Moderate Reformed; Sehling 20/1, p. 304):

[…] that the order of them which minister in the schools be the second after the order of Priests: among the ministers of the church, and in that place where of old the Deacons and subdeacons were, which also administered this function, when they were not performing the duties of clerics, [together] with the care of alms.

16.3.2 Homberg 1526: "Scripture knoweth no other ministers"

The Homberg church order (Moderate Reformed), which Francis Lambert drafted for the Hessian synod of 1526 and which was never put into force, is the only order that rejects the higher grades in so many words. It forbids the dalmatic and tunicle of the deacon and subdeacon because the orders they signify were "brought in without the testimony of God's words". **Hesse, *Homberger Kirchenordnung*, 1526, chapter [24]** (Moderate Reformed; Sehling 8, p. 46):

Let no man henceforth put on dalmatics, that is, the vestments of the papistical deacons, or of the subdeacons. For we will not favour those orders, which were brought in without the testimonies of the words of God. Moreover, Scripture knoweth no other ministers save bishops, or presbyters, and deacons of the poor. But of deacons of the mass we find not one jot in either

testament; albeit the helpers of the bishops be not unfitly called deacons, that is, ministers. For deacon signifieth a minister, and diaconia a ministry.

The passage shows the whole later position in small:

- There is one ministry of the word, in which bishop and presbyter are one.
- There is one apostolic diaconate, for the poor.
- A "deacon" who is the pastor's assistant is allowed, but only in the loose sense of "minister" or helper.

16.3.3 Human ordinances, tonsure and vestment

Elsewhere the minor orders go silently, together with the tonsure, the processional cross and the other "human ordinances" that the visitations swept away. **Freiberg, *Visitationsartikel* of Dr Jacob Schenk, 1537** (Sehling 1, p. 466):

All human ordinances which have hitherto been held as necessary shall be done away, notwithstanding that God had not forbidden them: as ringing [of bells] otherwise than for divine offices, going with the cross, [wearing] tonsures, wearing cowls, fast days, and choosing other set times.

Bugenhagen makes the same point positively about deacons. The true deacon of Acts 6 needs neither tonsure nor deacon's vestment: Stephen and Lawrence were deacons without them. **Brunswick, *Kirchenordnung* of Johannes Bugenhagen, 1528** (Sehling 6/1, p. 449):

Such deacons, since they hold the mystery of the faith in a pure conscience, can also well comfort with God's word the poor and wretched whom they help with money, as Saint Stephen did at Jerusalem, and Saint Lawrence at Rome, without tonsure and without deacon's coat. But with us, whatsoever pertaineth to the word of God with the sick, that do the preachers with their visiting; so that our deacons only procure money from the common chest for the needy.

Hamburg repeats the point when it allows Lawrence to be remembered in the sermon. **Hamburg, *Hamburger Kirchenordnung*, 1529** (Sehling 5, p. 514):

He bare no tonsure nor deacon's coat, but was a deacon, as it is written, Acts 6 and 1 Timothy 3.

What survived of the name *Subdiaconus*. In Württemberg, Electoral Saxony and some towns, *Subdiaconus* survived as the name of a **benefice**: the third preaching post of a town church, below the pastor, the preacher and the *Diaconus* (deacon). It was not a separate order. Württemberg's order for filling church posts treats "pastors, preachers, deacons, subdeacons" as one list of ministers of the word, each "called" and examined in the same way. **Württemberg, *Ordnung der Besetzung von Kirchendienerstellen*, 1559** (Sehling 16, p. 348):

Accordingly shall none be called or ordained to [be] Pastor, Preacher, Deacon, Subdeacon, Catechist, or to other service of the church, unless he first bring his credible and lawful testimonies of his birth, descent, [and] conduct […]

Electoral Saxony's great order of 1580 has a chapter "how all parishes, preacherships, diaconates and subdiaconates shall be filled". **Electoral Saxony, *Kirchenordnung* of Elector August, 1580**, table of contents and chapter heading (Sehling 1, pp. 363, 375):

Of the calling and receiving of the ministers of the church, and how all parishes, preacherships, diaconate and subdiaconate shall be filled.

At Halle the *Unterdiaconi*, the junior ministers, were bound to visit those they had communed in sickness. They were thus ministers of the sacrament, not servers. **Halle, *Kirchen-Ordnung der christlichen Gemein zu Hall in Sachsen*, 1573(?)** (Sehling 2, p. 441):

But the deacons, and especially the subdeacons, shall be bound to visit, unasked, in their sickness those whom they have communicated in bodily infirmities.

16.3.4 The one exception: the acolytes of the Bohemian Brethren

The *Ordo ecclesiasticus in unitate fratrum Bohemorum* (1576; Bohemian Brethren), printed in Sehling's Polish section, keeps a five-step clergy:

- **acolytes**, then **deacons**, then **ministers** (presbyters);
- above them, **con-seniors** and **seniors** (bishops).

The acolytes are boys and young men taken into the pastor's household to be trained for the ministry. The order justifies the grade from Samuel under Eli, Elisha under Elijah, the sons of the prophets, Christ's disciples and Paul's companions, and calls it apostolic. **Bohemian Brethren, *Ordo ecclesiasticus in unitate fratrum Bohemorum*, 1576** (Bohemian Brethren; Sehling 4, pp. 275–276):

Acolytes are young lads admitted by the pastors of the churches into [their] household fellowship, to this end, that for the future use of the church they may be instructed in letters and manners more diligently than with their parents or elsewhere. For so Samuel was wont to be exercised with Eli, 1 Samuel 3:1; Elisha with Elijah, 2 Kings 4:38; and the company of the sons of the prophets with their elders, 2 Kings 4. So also Christ cherished and exercised the disciples with himself before he had entrusted the ministry to them. […] And hence it is that this grade hath been used in the church even from the apostolic times.

What the acolytes did, according to the same order (p. 276):

- live modestly and in willing service;
- learn the catechism, the Gospels, the shorter Epistles, the Psalms and the hymns by heart;
- read the sacred text at household prayers, and sometimes give a short exhortation on it.

They had no altar duties. The medieval acolyte's candles and cruets have become a seminary apprenticeship.

The order calls their admission an *ordinatio*, "the first grade of calling". It takes place before the synod, after an examination, and it has **no laying on of hands**; the Brethren kept that for deacons and ministers (§16.5.3, §16.8). **Bohemian Brethren, *Ordo ecclesiasticus*, 1576, "Acoluthorum ordinatio"** (Bohemian Brethren; Sehling 4, p. 279):

Now the ordination is: I. Of Acolytes. II. Of Deacons. III. Of Ministers. IV. Of Con-seniors. V. Of Seniors. […] 2. They are called forth by name in order, and present themselves in the sight of the church. 3. They are asked before the whole synod whether they will consecrate themselves to the uses of the church, [and] whether they promise obedience. 4. Their duties are read to them, of which above. 5. The keeping of these they promise with hand given. 6. The former acolytes take them into [their] fellowship by reaching forth the right hand. 7. All is concluded with prayers, a blessing, and a sacred song.

16.3.5 Where the functions went

Porter. The porter's keys passed to the **sexton** (*Opfermann*, *Küster*, *Kirchner*, *Mesner*). This was a lay church servant, engaged and paid by the parish. Hesse 1566 (Moderate Reformed) draws the line from the Old Testament gatekeepers to the *aeditui* (sacristans) and *custodes* (keepers) of its own day. **Hesse, *Kirchenordnung*, 1566** (Moderate Reformed; Sehling 8, p. 211):

Besides the superintendents, pastors, elders and deacons, our churches have also certain other ministers, which, forasmuch as they have and keep the keys of the church wherein the christian congregation cometh together, [and] open and shut [it], are well nigh like unto them which in the old testament were called janitores, and today, as is customary, are called aeditui and custodes. These also, like other ministers of the church, shall be of an honest and godly conversation, no drunkards, [and] shall ply no dishonest trade. But the said sextons shall be received by the pastors and elders, with the knowledge and will of a superintendent.

Hamburg puts the sexton under the pastor "with locking, with ringing at the right time". He is hired and dismissed by the lay deacons who keep the church building (Sehling 5, p. 512). Nassau-Dillenburg 1582 (Reformed) has the *aeditui* elected by the presbytery with the elders and deacons (§16.5.3).

Lector. Public reading passed to three groups:

- **Schoolboys.** At Rostock a boy reads the epistle at Vespers in Latin and another reads it in German "to the people". **Rostock, *Conformitas ceremoniarum in singulis templis ecclesiae Rostochiensis*, 1560–1576** (Sehling 5, p. 289):

Thereafter shall the epistle be read in Latin by a youth, and after the epistle the responsory be sung; whereupon shall the epistle be read in German by a boy unto the people […]

- **The junior minister.** At Hof the *subdiaconus* (subdeacon), "a minister of the church", reads a collect drawn from the Sunday epistle, then the epistle, then its summary. **Hof, *Ordo ecclesiasticus*, 1592** (Sehling 11, p. 425):

A minister of the church, to wit the subdeacon, readeth a little prayer composed out of the Sunday or festival epistle; after that the epistle itself; and lastly the sum thereof.

- **The assisting minister (*levite*)** in Nürnberg, who reads a whole chapter "in place of the lesson" and expounds it (§16.4.3).

Exorcist. No exorcist appears anywhere. Strasbourg's view (1539, Moderate Reformed) that exorcism was a charism, not an office (§16.3.1), explains why. Where the exorcism in the baptismal rite was kept, the minister who baptised spoke it. The Reformed orders dropped even that. Bentheim-Tecklenburg orders the baptismal "exorcisms, which have no ground in the Word of God", to be abolished (Sehling 22, p. 269).

Acolyte. Outside the Bohemian Brethren (Hussite; §16.3.4), the acolyte's tasks at the altar either lapsed or fell to the ministrants of the early Mass orders (§16.4.1–16.4.2). The training role that the Brethren gave their acolytes was filled elsewhere by the **school**. Strasbourg calls the school ministry "second after the order of priests" (§16.3.1).

16.4 The liturgical roles

Most evangelical orders assume that the service is led by one minister at the altar, with the schoolmaster and boys as the choir and the sexton ringing the bells. The roles asked about are mostly absent:

- **Common:** the reader (§16.3.5).
- **Occasional:** the server or ministrant, and the assisting deacon and subdeacon at the altar.
- **Common only at funerals:** the cross-bearer, who is a schoolboy or the sexton, never a cleric.
- **Never prescribed as a role:** the thurifer, the boat-bearer, the candle-bearer and torch-bearer, and the master of ceremonies. Lights could still be carried at Brandenburg funerals (§16.4.4).

The early Mass-shaped orders of Nürnberg, Brandenburg, Pfalz-Neuburg and Regensburg are the exception. They keep assisting ministers at the altar for a time. Where those assistants are named, they are usually **ordained ministers** taking turns, not boys or men in minor orders.

16.4.1 Ministrants

The Nürnberg parish churches' order of 1524 keeps a *ministrant* at the altar. The priest asks him who has announced himself for communion. **Nürnberg, *Gottesdienstordnung der Pfarrkirchen*, 1524** (Sehling 11, p. 52):

After the alleluia the priest asketh the ministrant whether any have announced himself to receive the holy sacrament.

Elector Joachim II's order for Brandenburg (1540) has the celebrant wear a cope or surplice, not a chasuble. It allows ministrants "in deacons' coats" (dalmatics) where there are enough clergy, as in collegiate churches, monasteries and some large towns. **Brandenburg, *Kirchenordnung* of Joachim II, 1540** (Sehling 3, p. 71):

[…] where there can be had ministers of the church enough for it, as in foundations and cloisters, and also in certain great towns, ministrants in deacons' coats may also be used for such an office.

The same order keeps the "customary lights" at the hours and Masses. It abolishes only the special lights of the confraternities and guilds (Sehling 3, p. 71).

16.4.2 Deacon and subdeacon at the altar

Pfalz-Neuburg 1543 has the celebrant come to the altar "with his ministrants, where and when they are wont to be used". It then gives the epistle to the subdeacon, the gospel to the deacon, and the chalice to the deacon. Each of these applies only "where there are ministrants". **Pfalz-Neuburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1543** (Sehling 13, pp. 70–71):

First shall the priest which will hold the mass, together with his ministrants, where and when they are wont to be used, go to the altar in their customary church vestments after the custom of each church, and at the beginning, kneeling before it, say the Confiteor or a goodly penitential psalm. […] Afterward shall he, or the subdeacon if there be ministrants, read the epistle in German with a loud and understandable voice […] Thereafter shall he, or the deacon if there be ministrants, read the gospel likewise with a loud and understandable voice […]

At the distribution (Sehling 13, p. 75):

Likewise, where there are ministrants, the deacon shall reach the cup to them which have partaken of the body of Christ […] But where there are no ministrants, there shall the priest first reach the body of the Lord to every man, and only after that the cup.

Heilbronn's order of 1530 has the preacher stand at the rood altar "with his two deacons in surplices". The preacher speaks the words of Christ, and the deacons distribute. Heilbronn's *Diaconi* (deacons) were the town's assistant preachers. **Heilbronn, *„Confessio Heilbronnensis" und Kirchenordnung*, 1530** (Sehling 17/1, p. 285):

After the same the preacher turneth himself at the rood altar, with his two Deacons in surplices, toward the people, [and] proclaimeth the death of Christ, [and] what one ought to seek in the supper, to them that are then present. Thereafter the preacher speaketh the words of Christ over the bread and the wine; and after the same the Deacons reach the sacrament from the altar to them that desire it […]

In both orders the deacon distributes but does not consecrate. This division of labour runs through all the orders that have an assisting deacon.

The Regensburg order of 1553, drawn up under Justus Jonas, works with a weekly rota of the town's **ordained ministers**:

- the *Wochner* (the minister on duty that week) celebrates;
- the second minister, "ministrant or deacon", says the Confiteor with him and gives the cup;
- the third reads a chapter from the pulpit and holds the houseling cloth;
- the fourth, in a surplice, holds the cloth by the cup.

Regensburg, *Kirchenordnung unter Justus Jonas*, 1553 (Sehling 13, pp. 419–421):

First cometh the priest (that is, the minister which, as is above said, is of the week) with two ministrants or deacons before the altar […] The priest himself reacheth the body of Christ to the people on his side; the ministrant or deacon (which is second) reacheth the blood of Christ to the people on the other side of the altar. But the deacon which is third holdeth the little cloth on the side of the priest which reacheth the body. And he which is fourth holdeth the cloth beside the deacon which reacheth the blood, in a surplice. But where no minister is at hand, then the preacher or the pastor doeth it.

The places of the ministers at the altar are treated in Chapter 2, §2.15.8.

16.4.3 Levites: kept, then abolished

In the south German imperial cities, the two assistants at the altar were called **levites**, a gospeller and an epistoler. Sehling's editor notes that outside cathedrals they were in practice priests (Sehling 13, p. 391, note 6). Regensburg's first evangelical service, described in the "True Report" of 1542, has them in full. **Regensburg, *Wahrhaftiger Bericht*, 1542** (Sehling 13, pp. 391, 393):

During this litany three ministers of the church go out of the sacristy to the altar whereat the people is to be fed, namely, the priest which singeth the office, together with two levites, namely a gospeller and an epistoler; and the priest with the gospeller prayeth the Confiteor. Meanwhile the epistoler setteth in order the chalice, book, particles and paten upon the altar. […] But the epistoler holdeth the little cloth over which the people receiveth the body of Christ; and if any out of simplicity should use some awkwardness, him he instructeth and informeth how he ought to behave himself.

Nürnberg's report to the council of Goslar (1528) gives the levites the reading and the exhortation. One reads and expounds a whole chapter of the Epistles "in place of the lesson". One gives the exhortation to the communicants before the altar. **Nürnberg, *Bericht der Stadt Nürnberg für den Goslarer Rat*, 30 March 1528** (Sehling 7/2.2, p. 230):

After this one of the levites goeth up into the pulpit, and readeth in place of the lesson a whole chapter out of the epistles of Saint Peter, Saint Paul or Saint John […] Thereupon straightway one of the levites goeth before the altar and maketh in the German tongue a christian exhortation […]

Abolition. The levites, and the dalmatics and chasubles that went with them, were the target of deliberate abolition in the 1550s and 1560s. In April 1554 Nikolaus Gallus and the council of Regensburg had a declaration read to the congregation. It gives two grounds:

- The levitical garments come from the Old Testament priesthood and the papal Mass, both now ended in Christ.
- The pope now requires them as necessary to true worship, and Christian liberty must show "the contrary".

Regensburg, *Warum die leviten- und meßgewand sollen abgetan werden*, 29 April 1554 (Sehling 13, p. 432):

An honourable council, together with us ministers of the word, hath thought good that the levites' and mass vestments shall henceforth be wholly done away at the communion in our christian church here, as with many others. And that for the following causes. First, that both pieces (as in part the names yet shew) came into our church from the levitical priesthood of the old testament and from the pope's mass, and had their signification upon Christ which was to come. Since then in the new testament we are free from the laws of the levitical priesthood and quit of the pope's blasphemous mass, [and] have the body, Christ himself, and in the supper, according to the words of Christ, no more than a communion, we rightly let the Jewish shadow go, together with that which hangeth upon and serveth the pope's mass. Secondly, the levites' and mass vestments were not only wrongly brought by the pope into the christian church of the new testament, but are yet commanded by him anew, and required as necessary to the true service of God with superstitious and idolatrous opinion. Therefore, as we are otherwise rightly separated from the pope, from his false doctrine and false service of God, so shall we also herein be wholly parted from him henceforth, and, for the shewing of our christian liberty, prove the contrary in this case.

Regensburg's church order of 1567(?) records that the levites, the vestments and the altar lights were all "let fall" in the end. **Regensburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1567(?)** (Sehling 13, p. 480):

Accordingly we have also at last let fall the church vesture, as chasubles, stoles, levites etc., as also the lights, which from the beginning of the pure doctrine were nevertheless kept a long time in our parish, together with certain of the holy days above mentioned; for the causes that these things were brought without understanding out of the old testament, from the levitical priesthood, which hath its end, into the new testament, and turned into mere papistical idolatry.

The chapter order of Brandenburg-Ansbach (1565, revised 1578) forbids them outright at the clergy's chapter meetings. **Brandenburg-Ansbach-Kulmbach, *Kapitelsordnung*, 1565/78** (Sehling 11, p. 357):

Neither shall any levites be set forth after the papistical use.

16.4.4 Thurifer, boat-bearer and candle-bearer

Luther's *Formula missae* (Form of the Mass) leaves both candles and incense at the gospel free. **Luther, *Formula missae et communionis pro ecclesia Wittembergensi*, 1523** (Sehling 1, p. 5):

Sixthly followeth the reading of the gospel. Wherein we neither forbid candles nor censing, but neither do we require them. Let this be free.

Lippe (1538) lists incense among the abuses to be dropped from the Mass, while it leaves vestments, albs and lights free. **Lippe, *Lippische Kirchenordnung*, 1538** (Sehling 21, p. 318):

[…] with certain short ceremonies, without water in the chalice, incense, the making of many crosses, and other abuses. But chasubles, albs, lights [and] rochets are free.

No later order in the corpus takes up Luther's freedom for incense. **No order prescribes a thurifer or a boat-bearer.** Censing is mentioned only in descriptions of the old Mass, or in lists of things abolished.

Altar lights were kept in many Lutheran territories, as in Brandenburg 1540 above. But they were lit and tended by the **sexton**, and no order makes carrying them a liturgical role. **No candle-bearer (*accensor*, *ceroferarius*) or torch-bearer is prescribed**, not even at the gospel or the elevation. Regensburg let its lights fall with the levites (§16.4.3). Lights were still carried in two places outside the service. Electoral Brandenburg let the old custom of carrying lights at funerals "remain with measure" (Sehling 3, p. 81). The early Baden order of 1533 kept the sacrament carried to the sick "with light and bells going before" (Sehling 16, p. 510). Neither names who carried them.

16.4.5 Cross-bearer, and the roles not found

The processional cross went with the processions themselves. Freiberg 1537 lists "going with the cross" among the human ordinances to be done away (§16.3.3). In Brandenburg it survived in the Rogation-tide procession, where it is carried before the

schoolboys, the priests and the people. **Stendal, ordinance of the visitors of the Mark Brandenburg, 1541** (Sehling 3, p. 314):

[…] and afterward hold the processions in order: as, first, to carry a cross before, thereafter the scholars, following them the priests, and after them the men, maidens and women […]

Schwäbisch Hall's church order of 1543, in its revision of 1615, allows a cross before a coffin. It must be used "not effectively but significatively", that is, as a sign that the dead died trusting in Christ's cross, not as a thing that works anything. **Schwäbisch Hall, *Kirchenordnung* 1543/1615, *Ordnung der Begrebnus*** (Sehling 17/1, p. 173):

Inasmuch as it is also not in itself wrong to carry a cross before the corpse, when it is done without superstition and idolatry; namely so, that it be used not effectively but significatively, to shew that the dead man died upon the cross of Jesus Christ.

No order makes the **crucifer** an office, but several name the bearer, and he is never a cleric:

- **A schoolboy.** In Anhalt's order of the German hymns (before 1551) "a boy from the school shall carry a cross on a staff before the procession" at burials (Sehling 2, p. 555). At Prenzlau in 1557 the cross is "carried before by the scholars" (Sehling 3, p. 261).
- **The sexton.** In Waldeck in 1556 "the sexton or *Opfermann* shall go with a cross", followed by the schoolboys, the schoolmaster and the pastor (Sehling 9, p. 256).

In Electoral Brandenburg the cross went before the schoolboys and the priests at every funeral (Sehling 3, p. 81). Freiberg in 1538 required a crucifix at every burial (Sehling 1, p. 468). The full evidence on who walked in processions and what was carried is in Chapter 13 §13.18.4.

Not found. The corpus contains no prescribed role of **candle-bearer** (*accensor*, *ceroferarius* [candle-bearer]), **torch-bearer**, **boat-bearer** or **master of ceremonies**. The nearest thing to the last is the **cantor** or schoolmaster, who directs the choir and the sung parts of the service. He is a school officer, not a liturgical minister. The orders of service are addressed to the pastor himself, and they set out the ceremonies he is to observe.

16.5 The diaconate

The diaconate survived in three forms, and an order often has more than one of them under the same name:

- the **Lutheran *Diaconus***: an ordained assistant minister of the word and sacraments (§16.5.1);
- the **liturgical deacon**: an assistant at the altar, normally himself one of the ordained ministers (§16.4.2–16.4.3);
- the **lay deacon of the poor**: an elected steward of alms and church goods, based on Acts 6 (§16.5.2–16.5.3).

16.5.1 The Lutheran *Diaconus*: an assistant minister, ordained like a pastor

In the Lutheran town churches the *Diaconus* (deacon; also *Helfer* [assistant], *Kaplan* [chaplain], *Capellan* [chaplain]) is a second or third minister, and the *Subdiaconus* (§16.3.3) a third or fourth. Each preaches, baptises, hears confession, communes the sick and gives the cup at the altar. Halle provides each of its three parish churches with "a pastor and two deacons, who are all fit to preach, to reach the sacrament and to perform other church business". **Halle, *Kirchen-Ordnung der christlichen Gemein zu Hall in Sachsen*, 1573(?)** (Sehling 2, p. 442):

[…] that the three parish churches now established and oft named, St Mary, St Ulrich and [St] Maurice, be provided and maintained with three persons, namely one pastor and two deacons, which are all fit to preach, to reach the sacrament, and to perform other business of the church.

The same ordination. The *Diaconus* is ordained with the same rite as the pastor. Electoral Saxony's form for ordaining and investing "a new minister of the church" names "the new pastor or deacon" throughout. The superintendent lays his right hand on him, as a ceremony "of christian liberty". He then "ordains, confirms and establishes" him, "by divine command and ordinance, to be a minister and curate of souls of this congregation". **Electoral Saxony, *Kirchenordnung* of Elector August, 1580** (Sehling 1, pp. 382–383):

During the singing the superintendent shall step before the altar, call the new pastor or deacon to him, and cause him to kneel before him to prayer […] the superintendent shall turn himself before the altar toward the people, and, as is customary (according to the christian liberty given by the Lord Christ to the church in outward indifferent ceremonies), lay his right hand

upon the bare head of the new pastor or deacon, and say thus: Forasmuch as we, gathered in the Holy Ghost, have called upon and prayed God our heavenly Father through Jesus Christ our Lord and Saviour over thee, and therefore doubt not that he, according to his divine promise, hath graciously heard and granted us; therefore I ordain, confirm and establish thee, by divine command and ordinance, to be a minister and curate of souls of this congregation [...]

A step, not an order. The diaconate is normally the first post of a young minister, but it is not a necessary stage. The same order allows a candidate of exceptional gifts to be made a pastor "without the means of the diaconate". **Electoral Saxony, *Kirchenordnung*, 1580** (Sehling 1, pp. 381–382):

But if one be found in the examination so learned, apt and experienced, and furnished with gifts to teach, and already practised in preaching, and moreover sufficiently instructed in the rites of the church, then may there be dispensation with him, and such a person may be appointed and received to be a pastor without the means of the diaconate.

This Lutheran diaconate is therefore a **rank in one ministry**, distinguished by benefice, seniority and duties. It is not a sacramental grade. The *Diaconus* could do everything the pastor did. He was subject to the pastor, as the pastor was to the superintendent, by "human" order (§16.5.4).

The deacon's duties alongside the pastor are treated in Chapter 15, §15.3.5.

16.5.2 Lay deacons of the poor in the Lutheran orders

Bugenhagen's orders for Brunswick (1528), Hamburg (1529) and Lübeck (1531) created the most widespread lay diaconate of the Reformation. These are the **deacons of the common chest** (*diakene der schatkaste*) and **deacons of the poor** (*diakene der armen*): honest burghers elected for a term to keep the treasury, collect and distribute alms, and look after the ministers' maintenance. Bugenhagen grounds the office on Acts 6 and the qualifications in 1 Timothy 3, which he expounds clause by clause. In passing he equates bishops and preachers. **Brunswick, *Kirchenordnung* of Johannes Bugenhagen, 1528** (Sehling 6/1, p. 449):

[...] that the deacons shall be honest, such as have a good report, that as honourable, godly people they deal not wrongly in any thing. Item, that they be not double-tongued; for how can one commit such money and the service of the poor to him that loveth to lie and to backbite, [that] saith white before mine eyes and elsewhere black? Such are wont also to stir up strife and falling away against the bishops or preachers (which is all one thing), etc. Item: not given to wine, or a drunkard; for such an one will seek his collation out of the money of the poor [...]

What they might not do. Bugenhagen's deacons do not minister the word. In the early Church Stephen and Lawrence comforted the poor with God's word, but "with us" the visiting of the sick belongs to the preachers, and "our deacons only procure money from the common chest for the needy" (§16.3.3).

Collegiate control. In Hamburg 3 or 4 deacons alone may not lend or make any substantial grant from the poor's goods. That is done only when "the sixteen deacons" meet on Saturday. **Hamburg, *Hamburger Kirchenordnung*, 1529** (Sehling 5, p. 535):

To lend, or to give any thing of substance, out of these goods of the poor, three or four deacons shall not take upon themselves; but it shall be done when on the Saturday the sixteen deacons, or the most of them if some cannot come, are together [...]

Lübeck's order of 1531 follows Hamburg's. Every Saturday the three youngest deacons of each parish, who hold the keys, empty the poor chest and carry its contents to St Mary's (Sehling 5, p. 359).

Hamburg's deacons also hire and dismiss the sexton and the organists. They care for the widows and orphans of deceased preachers. They give yearly gifts to the midwives, who in turn report poor women in childbed to them (Sehling 5, pp. 512–513).

Other names for the same office. The lay deacon of the poor appears under several names:

- ***Leviten*** in the Land Hadeln. They collect at the church door during the general prayer, go from house to house once a year for corn, admit the deserving poor to the hospitals "by the counsel and with the will of the pastor", and maintain the preachers and the poor from the common chest. **Hadeln, *Hadelner Kirchenordnung*, 1526** (Sehling 5, p. 472):

[...] that the levites, as they are called, shall maintain therewith the preachers and the true poor. [...] Every Sunday and high feast one of the levites shall go about with the bag in the church while the preacher standeth in the pulpit and maketh the common

prayer. […] By the counsel and with the will of the pastor the levites shall take into the guest-houses or hospitals other house-poor, which are truly poor.

- ***Subdiaconi oder Bittherren*** at St Wenzel's in Naumburg. There are twelve: three from the council and the rest from the community. They stand at the church doors with collecting boards. **Naumburg, *Kirchen-Ordnung für die St. Wenzelskirche*, 1537** (Sehling 2, p. 64):

Of the beggar-lords. Thereafter shall twelve subdeacons, or beggar-lords, be appointed, three out of the council, seven out of the community; of whom every holy day six shall stand before the church doors as soon as the sermon is out, before each door one, with a board, and beg the alms for the poor people […]

- ***Diaconi*** in Pomerania. At Pyritz (1539) two come from the council and two from the guilds. They are expressly **not** put under oath, but they must render account yearly. **Pyritz, *Abschied*, 1539** (Sehling 4, p. 519):

The visitors desire to be informed out of what body the deacons are chosen. Whereto answer was made, that two out of the council and two from the guilds are chosen to be deacons, but are not laden with any oath, and must every year render account before the council at Pyritz.

The Pomeranian synod of 1574 requires the opposite, an **oath**. **Pomerania, *Statuta synodica*, 1574** (Sehling 4, p. 491):

II. Let the pastors take heed that fit deacons of the church and of the poor be chosen, and that the same bind their faith to the church or to the poor by oath, according to the church order, and yearly render account in the presence of the magistrate and the pastor.

- ***Diaconi, dat is der armen dieners*** in Lippe (1538). Every parish church is to "ordain" them and set up a common chest. The word *ordiniren* (ordain) here means no more than to appoint. **Lippe, *Lippische Kirchenordnung*, 1538** (Sehling 21, p. 335):

Therefore it is needful for every parish church to ordain deacons, that is, servants of the poor, and to set up a common chest […]

The office spread to the Lutheran stranger churches. The **Dutch congregation of the Augsburg Confession at Frankfurt** founded its poor chest in 1585 and chose as its first *diaconi* (deacons) Michael Bode and Lorenz, "the schoolmaster here". **Frankfurt, *Stiftungsbrief des Armenkastens der Niederländischen Gemeinde A. C.*, 1585** (Lutheran; Sehling 9, p. 604):

[…] in that they chose for the first deacons Michael Bode and Lorenz, the schoolmaster here, and for deputies the lords Arnd van Nieden, Peter van Leyden and Renatus Verbeke (absent), which in the name of the Lord have taken upon them this their office.

Sehling's editors of the Hildesheim volume point out that Bugenhagen counted the maintenance of ministers and the poor as part of "divine order". They conclude that the deacon's office must, by its function, be of divine right (§16.5.4).

16.5.3 Hesse, the Reformed churches and the Bohemian Brethren: deacons as an ordained lay office

In the Hessian order of 1566 (Moderate Reformed) and in the Reformed orders, the deacon of the poor becomes one of the **standing offices** of the congregation, alongside the ministers of the word and the elders. He is chosen by the Spirit's own rule (Acts 6:3; 1 Timothy 3:8–12), put on probation (1 Timothy 3:10), and **ordained**.

Hesse 1566 (Moderate Reformed) gives the scriptural qualifications. **Hesse, *Kirchenordnung*, 1566** (Moderate Reformed; Sehling 8, p. 210):

[…] the Holy Ghost himself hath shewed us what manner of men should be chosen and used for this office. Ye must choose, say the apostles (Acts 6:3), men which have a good report and are full of the Holy Ghost and wisdom. And the holy apostle Paul, 1 Timothy 3[:8f., 12]: the deacons shall be grave, not double-tongued, not given to wine, not plying a dishonest trade, which hold the mystery of the faith in a pure conscience, the husband of one wife […] and which rule their children and whole household well. (In the margin: Probation.) They then which are chosen shall exercise and employ themselves for a time with the others which are in this office, that they may prepare and make themselves apt for this office beforehand, to the end that hereby also their faith, diligence and uprightness may be proved and tried in them.

Hesse (1566, Moderate Reformed) holds that the apostles ordained deacons "with common prayer and laying on of hands". It therefore ordains both elders and deacons in their own church, while noting that the deacon's office "is not equal to the service

of the elders". **Hesse, *Kirchenordnung*, 1566** (Moderate Reformed; Sehling 8, pp. 207–208):

The apostles also ordained and confirmed the deacons with common prayer and laying on of hands, Acts 6[:1–6]; which office nevertheless is by no means equal to the service of the elders. But these elders, and the deacons also, shall always be ordained in the same church which they are to serve; and this shall be performed either by the superintendent, when he visiteth there, or else by some pastor together with one or two ministers of the word.

Micron's *Ordinancien* (Reformed). These are the order of the Dutch stranger church in London (1554), as printed for Norden in East Frisia in 1565. They set "four deacons or ministers of the poor, after the apostolic order" beside the elders. **Micron, *Ordinancien* (1554) 1565** (Reformed; Sehling 7/1, p. 583):

Soon after we also received, with the consent of the congregation, four deacons or ministers of the poor after the apostolic order.

The deacons are confirmed with a form modelled on that for the elders (§16.6.3). They are presented to the congregation and questioned:

- whether they feel the inward witness of the Spirit;
- whether they hold the prophetic and apostolic doctrine sufficient;
- whether they will gather and distribute the alms faithfully "without respect of persons";
- whether they will submit to Christian discipline.

The congregation prays, "as thou didst give thy Spirit to Stephen". Then hands are laid on them. **Micron, *Ordinancien* (1554) 1565, chapter VII, "Form of the confirmation of the deacons or almoners"** (Reformed; Sehling 7/1, pp. 597–598):

Will ye not diligently gather the alms for the profit of the poor, and faithfully and wisely distribute that which is gathered unto the poor, and especially unto the household of faith, without any outward respect of the person, but only according to each one's need and poverty? They answer: Yea, we will, by the grace of God. […] When the prayer is ended, hands are laid upon them, and the minister saith with a clear voice thus: God the Lord and our heavenly Father, which hath called you to the service of the diaconate, govern you graciously with his divine power, wisdom and goodness […]

Sehling's editor notes that in **London** (Reformed) the elders and the deacons had been installed with prayer and laying on of hands since 1550. In **Emden** (Reformed) laying on of hands "is not attested", and the deacons there were apparently not installed after the same pattern as the elders (Sehling 7/1, pp. 554–555, editor's introduction).

Without laying on of hands. Several Reformed orders install deacons with no laying on of hands:

- **Kurpfalz (1563)**, followed by **Moers (1581)** and **Bentheim-Tecklenburg** (1588/1619), all Reformed. They have "pious and godly men, whom they call *diaconi* or almoners", elected per 1 Timothy 3:8. They collect the alms on Sundays and distribute them, and are confirmed "with the knowledge and will of the pastors and appointed seniors". No laying on of hands is mentioned. **Bentheim-Tecklenburg, *Bentheim-Tecklenburger Kirchenordnung*, 1588/1619** (Reformed; Sehling 22, p. 276):

[…] pious and godly men, whom men call Deacons or Almoners, be chosen, and confirmed with the knowledge and will of the Pastors and the appointed Seniors, according to the doctrine and use of the holy Apostles […]

- **Nassau-Dillenburg (1582)** (Reformed). Here the deacon is the fourth of four offices: ministers, doctors, seniors and deacons. The presbytery elects the seniors, the deacons of the poor and the sextons (*aeditui*), and the classis confirms them. The minister alone receives "confirmation or ordination". **Nassau-Dillenburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 23 January 1582** (Reformed; Sehling 10, p. 160):

The offices are fourfold: some of ministers, some of doctors, some of seniors, some of deacons. […] 4. Let the calling of ministers be made by the judgement of the classis and of some seniors; whereunto pertain these four: election, examination, approbation, and confirmation or ordination. […] 5. As touching the choosing of seniors, deacons of the poor and sextons, let the power of choosing be with the presbytery; who afterward shall be confirmed by the vote of the classical assembly and be diligently admonished of [their] office.

The Bohemian Brethren (Hussite). Their deacon is something else: an ordained **clerical** grade between acolyte and minister. The deacons are "older acolytes", preparing for the ministry. The order defends the grade as kept "constantly in the primitive

church", which must not be cast out though Antichrist abused it. **Bohemian Brethren, *Ordo ecclesiasticus*, 1576** (Hussite; Sehling 4, p. 276):

Deacons are the older acolytes, now presently preparing themselves for the future ministry. These the ministers of the brethren have for assistants or helpers, after the example of the apostles, Acts 6:2 and Philippians 1:1. For although they were ordained by the apostles primarily to the ministry of tables, yet it is certain that they both preached and baptised (as Stephen, Acts 6:10, and Philip, Acts 8:5, 12, 35, 38) and were promoted to a higher grade, namely of the ministry or presbytery, 1 Timothy 3:13. Therefore this grade of the diaconate was constantly kept in the primitive church, as appeareth from the canons of the councils. Which therefore, although it hath been drawn into abuse by the antichrist with the rest, it is not fitting to cast out of the church.

What the Brethren's deacons did (same page):

- study theology;
- teach the young the rudiments;
- practise preaching;
- baptise "as often as the pastor shall command".

At a crowded communion they help distribute both the bread and the cup, but with one limit: only a minister "having the power of the keys" pronounces the absolution and recites the words of institution. **Bohemian Brethren, *Ordo ecclesiasticus*, 1576** (Hussite; Sehling 4, p. 276):

As often as the holy supper is administered in a more numerous assembly, and sufficient ministers are not present, the deacons also are employed to distribute not only the cup but also the bread; yet so that none but a minister having the power of the keys announce the absolution to the people and solemnly set forth before the words of institution.

They are ordained before the synod, with an examination by the seniors, a vow, prayer and the **laying on of hands**, "Acts 6:6". **Bohemian Brethren, *Ordo ecclesiasticus*, 1576, "Ordination of deacons"** (Hussite; Sehling 4, p. 279):

3. They bind themselves to Christ and the church by a vow. 4. Prayers are made for them, and the ordainer confirmeth them by the laying on of hands, Acts 6:6. 5. The new deacons offer to the seniors and ministers the right hand of holy obedience; and the former deacons [offer] to them [the right hand] of fellowship. 6. The act is closed with a blessing.

16.5.4 Divine right or human right?

The question as the church orders put it. No order asks whether the diaconate is a separate *order* by divine right in the Roman sense. The orders ask two other questions:

1. Is there one ministry of the word, of which bishop, pastor and deacon are grades?
2. Is the deacon of the poor a lasting institution of the apostles?

One ministry; grades by human right. The orders consistently say that bishop, presbyter and pastor are one office:

- Homberg 1526 (Moderate Reformed): "bishops, or presbyters" (§16.3.2).
- Bugenhagen 1528: "bishops or preachers (which is all one thing)" (§16.5.2).
- Pfalz-Zweibrücken 1539. It describes the ancient Church as installing a minister "by one or two of the nearest bishops, whom men also call pastors". It says that it now has "certain of the nearest pastors or elders" lay hands on the new minister. **Pfalz-Zweibrücken, *Kirchenordnung „Form und Ordnung“*, 1539** (Sehling 18, p. 63):

[…] that the congregation chose one, who was set in office and confirmed by one or two of the nearest bishops, whom men also call pastors or parsons. […] Those then which were found apt for this office in doctrine and life, upon them have certain of the nearest pastors or elders in the congregation of God, as aforesaid, laid hands upon the head, and prayed that the Holy Ghost would enlighten and preserve the ministers of the word in christian doctrine and life.

Where distinctions within the ministry are defended, they are defended as **human order for the sake of good order**. Melanchthon's *Wittenberg Reformation* (1545) keeps bishops "as a grade above other priests" so that, "so far as human foresight can consider", there may be a lasting order. **Ernestine Saxony, *Wittenbergische Reformation*, 1545** (Sehling 1, p. 217):

[…] among these curates of souls there must nevertheless be an order; they have not all like gifts, they cannot all be judges in weighty articles of doctrine; they cannot all order and hold the courts. […] and the same places must be so provided with persons

and maintenance that there be, so far as human foresight can consider, a lasting order. Therefore must there be bishops, as a grade above other priests […]

The same text sets "divine and eternal right" apart from "human, transitory ordinance of things indifferent" (Sehling 1, p. 218). The Lutheran *Diaconus* (deacon), the *Subdiaconus* and the superintendent all stand on the second footing. Electoral Saxony can therefore dispense a candidate from the diaconate altogether (§16.5.1). Its ordination rite also calls the laying on of hands a ceremony of "christian liberty", while it calls the ministry itself a "divine command and ordinance".

The deacon of the poor as apostolic. The lay deacon of the poor is, by contrast, defended as apostolic in origin:

- **Homberg** (1526, Moderate Reformed; §16.3.2) knows only "bishops, or presbyters, and deacons of the poor".
- **Strasbourg** (1539, Moderate Reformed; §16.3.1) says the deacon alone of the lower grades was instituted "by the Holy Ghost through the Apostles". Its list of the three ministries that every church needs "even today" includes "the care of the poor".
- **Hesse 1566** (Moderate Reformed) and **Micron** (Reformed) cite Acts 6 and 1 Timothy 3. They say the Holy Ghost "himself hath shewed" what men should be chosen, and they ordain deacons as the apostles did.
- **The Bohemian Brethren** (Hussite) hold that the diaconate "was constantly kept in the primitive church" and must not be cast out. In practice, though, they treat it as a probationary step towards the presbyterate.

Of Bugenhagen, the editors of the Hildesheim volume write (Sehling 7/2.1, p. 811, editor's introduction):

It is noteworthy that Bugenhagen, in his Schleswig-Holstein church order of 1542 and in his Wolfenbüttel church order of 1543, reckoneth the maintenance of the ministers of church and school, and also of the poor, to the divine order, over against which he setteth the human order. From this, by its function, the office of deacon must accordingly be of divine right. It standeth in the divine order of right beside the office of preaching!

Lay deacons. In this sense **every** Lutheran deacon of the common chest, and every Reformed deacon, was a **lay deacon**. He was a man who kept his trade and served a term, elected by council and congregation or by the presbytery, and he had no part in preaching or the sacraments. The Lutheran *Diaconus*, by contrast, was never a layman. The Bohemian deacon was a cleric in training.

16.6 Elders

Two kinds of elders. Almost every order that speaks of governing elders starts from 1 Timothy 5:17, "the elders that rule well […] especially they who labour in the word and doctrine". From that verse it distinguishes two kinds of elder (*presbyter*, *senior*, *Eltester*):

- those who **labour in the word**: the ministers;
- those who **only govern**: the lay elders.

Lineage. The lay elder came into the German orders through Bucer, at Strasbourg and in Hesse (both Moderate Reformed). It was then generalised in the Reformed orders of East Frisia, Kurpfalz, Nassau and the Wetterau counties.

In the Lutheran orders "elder" is either a churchwarden without spiritual jurisdiction or a senior pastor (§16.6.5).

16.6.1 Strasbourg: the disciplinary *seniores*

The Strasbourg examination order of about 1539 (Moderate Reformed) already speaks of a second "order of presbyters", those "employed only for the discipline of the church" (§16.3.1). Its authority is twofold:

- the elders of the synagogue;
- Ambrose on 1 Timothy 5. Ambrose complains that such elders had lapsed through "the sloth or rather the pride of the teachers, who alone wish to seem something".

Marbach's Lutheran church order of 1553 identifies the city's *Kirchenpfleger* (churchwardens) with those *seniores*. They are elected to oversee the "whole householding of the church", which the preachers cannot manage alone. It reads the "church" of Matthew 18 as these elected men, not the whole assembly. **Strasbourg, *Kirchenordnung* of Johannes Marbach, 1553, "Of the churchwardens and their office"** (Sehling 20/1, p. 441):

Out of the Acts of the Apostles it is to be seen that in the first christian church, beside the apostles which preached the gospel, certain were chosen and ordained thereto by the congregation, which should have a special oversight, that everywhere house might be rightly kept, that none might neglect to live godly according to his calling, and so good order be kept in the church as in the house of God; whom they named seniores and presbyteri. […] Therefore the Lord Christ, Matthew 18[:15–18], biddeth that the impenitent and obstinate be told to the church, that they may be rebuked by it and admonished to true conversion. But by the church the Lord understandeth not the whole congregation as it cometh together to hear the word, but those which in orderly wise are chosen and given thereto by such assembly, to treat in the name and on behalf of the church all manner of church matters that fall out […]

16.6.2 Hesse: elders elected, "sanctified" and finally ordained

The Ziegenhain discipline order (1539) (Moderate Reformed), written under Bucer's influence, introduces elders into every Hessian congregation. They are chosen by the church "according to the canon of Paul", as the ministers are. It would be good, the order says, to confirm them publicly "with prayer and exhortation" and so to "sanctify their office". The civil authority is to uphold their office as the most necessary "after the office of teaching". **Hesse, *Ziegenhainer Zuchtordnung*, 1539** (Moderate Reformed; Sehling 8, p. 103):

These elders shall every church choose, as also the ministers of the word, with faithful regard to the canon of Paul. And it were good also that they should be confirmed in the church with public prayer and exhortation (to them, the elders, to attend diligently to their office; to the congregation, to obey the same elders heartily in the Lord), and their office so be sanctified. Whose office and service the magistracy also shall faithfully exalt and uphold, as the most necessary and wholesome service and office that may be in the church after the office of teaching.

The Hessian church order of 1566 (Moderate Reformed) makes the elders a permanent college in every parish. The superintendent's instructions open with this (Sehling 8, p. 195):

The first is, that in all churches of your district seniors, that is, elders, be chosen and ordained, which may be helpful both to you in this place and to the other pastors in their churches with counsel and deed and all their power; with whom ye may also take counsel of all matters which fall out in the government of the church, and advisedly treat of all things with all speed. Thereof saith Luke thus (Acts 14:23): They ordained elders here and there in the congregation, prayed and fasted, and commended them to the Lord on whom they believed.

Election and qualifications. The order appeals to Ambrose for the antiquity of the office. The ministers, together with men of the council and the congregation, elect the elders by vote (Acts 14:23). The elders must be of the same zeal and life as preachers, "only that they need not be so excellently learned". **Hesse, *Kirchenordnung*, 1566, "How the elders shall be chosen and ordained for the government of the church"** (Moderate Reformed; Sehling 8, p. 207):

Therefore in every church the ministers of the same congregation, together with certain appointed thereto both from the council and from the congregation, shall choose these elders. Of the form and manner of the election it is found in Acts 14 that it was done commonly by suffrages and voices. But to this office one must choose and have even such people, so far as concerneth zeal and life, as for the office of preaching; save only that they need not be so excellently learned.

Their charge. The ordination address sets the elders "beside the bishops", placed by the Holy Ghost to rule the church. They are to assist the ministers as councillors assist a burgomaster. Above all they are to guard against falsification of doctrine, whether by the public preachers or by "false teachers and wolves". **Hesse, *Kirchenordnung*, 1566** (Moderate Reformed; Sehling 8, p. 208):

Ye have heard, my beloved in the Lord, that beside the bishops elders also are set by the Holy Ghost for the government of the church of God. Therefore it will behove you that ye take especial great care and be diligent how the church may be well ruled, and that ye be furthersome in all things to the other ministers which labour in the word with faithful counsel and help, even as valiant and wise councillors also behave themselves toward the burgomaster where a good order is to be set up in the common weal. (1) But above all things ye shall, together with the other ministers of the church, with highest diligence prevent that no falsifying of doctrine be brought in, whether by those which preach publicly in the church, or by false teachers and wolves which secretly creep in beside and will craftily deceive […]

Ordination. After the prayer the pastor and the other ministers lay hands on the elders, "as also before said", using the rite of the ministers' ordination (Sehling 8, p. 209):

Thereafter shall the pastor and the other ministers lay their hands upon them, as is also said before, etc. (9) After all this, the ordinands shall be set in the midst, and the church committed to them to care for and to govern with such words: So we commit unto you this church, in which ye have been chosen to be elders […]

Elders at the ordination of ministers. The traffic also runs the other way. At the ordination of a new minister of the word, the elders lay on hands with the superintendent and the ministers (Sehling 8, p. 205):

After the prayer the superintendent, together with the other ministers of the word and elders, shall lay hands upon the ordinands […]

The editor of the Hessian volume notes that Johannes a Lasco (Reformed) also knew an ordination of the governing elders and of the deacons (Sehling 8, p. 208, note 97).

16.6.3 The Reformed orders: four offices, elders who govern with the ministers

Micron's *Ordinancien* (London 1554, printed for Norden 1565; Reformed) gives the classic Reformed account. There are two "kinds" (*geschlechte*) of elders. Some labour in word and doctrine, and are called bishops, shepherds and teachers. Others "minister not the public service of the word and sacraments", but are helpers of the ministers. Paul calls these "governments" (1 Corinthians 12:28). One of the elders presides, and the king's charter calls him the superintendent. **Micron, *Ordinancien* (1554) 1565** (Reformed; Sehling 7/1, pp. 587–588):

[…] and the other elders, although they minister not the public service of the word and of the sacraments, yet are they helpers of the other ministers, and stand by them with all earnestness, with counsel and help, that the congregation of God may be ruled and preserved in all godliness, holiness, peace, order and honesty according to the word of God; wherefore they are also called by Paul governments. Among these two kinds of elders one out of their number is the chief, orderly chosen thereto, that by his authority an accordant agreement may be held among all in all things according to the word of God. And he is called by the king's majesty in their privilege superintendent, that is, overseer. But the deacons take care for the poor of the congregation.

The elders are confirmed after questions and prayer by **laying on of hands**, "by the other ministers and by the minister of the word" (Reformed; Sehling 7/1, p. 596). The words are nearly those later used in Kurpfalz, given below.

Kurpfalz (Reformed). The elders of the Electoral Palatinate were set up by the edict of 1570, after the dispute with Erastus. Sehling's editors describe that dispute in their introduction (Sehling 14, p. 53, editors' introduction):

What was in dispute was not the exercise of discipline as such, but the question by whom, in what cases and in what manner it was to be handled. The advocates of the Calvinist church discipline stood on the line of the Catechism and the church order, and underlined the divine right of the presbyteries, the necessity of exclusion from the supper of false teachers and of sinners unwilling to amend, by this [presbytery], and in principle the sharp separation of a temporal and an ecclesiastical power of punishment.

The decision fell in 1569, with opinions by Beza, Ursinus and Zanchi against Erastus. On 13 July 1570 the edict set up church discipline and the classical assemblies. The editors add that Erastus still won concessions, including the involvement of the magistrate in excommunication (same page).

Under Frederick IV a new form for installing the elders was issued, dated 9 December 1592; the editors say the new elders were installed at the end of the New Year's service. Its title is "Form, how the elders which labour not in the word are confirmed in the congregation". The elders are questioned:

- whether they feel the witness of the Spirit;
- whether Scripture contains all that is needful to salvation;
- whether they will assist the ministers and accept correction themselves.

The congregation prays, and then hands are laid on them. **Kurpfalz, *Einführung der Senioren*, 9 December 1592** (Reformed; Sehling 19/2, pp. 789–790):

Form, how the elders which labour not in the word are confirmed in the congregation, etc. […] Thereafter hands are laid upon them by the other ministers and by the minister of the word, who speaketh with a clear voice thus: God and our heavenly Father, which hath called and separated you with us to the government of this his congregation (according to the doctrine of his word),

enlighten you also by his Holy Spirit and strengthen you with the power of his invincible hand, that ye may fulfil your service faithfully and constantly, to the honour of his name and the edifying of his congregation. Amen. […] Lastly he turneth his speech to the elders received, and admonisheth them that they regard not the contempt and hatred of the world, respect no person, but that they admonish, amend and rebuke every one without respect of person according to the use of christian rebuke; that they also take earnest heed to the doctrine, manners, yea, to the whole life of all ministers of the word; [and] ward off the wolves from the flock of the congregation together with the ministers of the word […]

The editors of the volume stress the point: "it is especially noteworthy that they are **ordained by laying on of hands** by the minister of the church and the individual elders continuing in office" (Sehling 19/2, p. 695, editors' introduction). The same form was adopted in Ysenburg-Ronneburg in 1592 (Reformed) (Sehling 10, p. 601).

Kurpfalz about 1601 (Reformed). The Palatine *Presbyterordnung* of about 1601 defines the presbytery as "certain persons chosen yearly" beside the ministers, "as elders and overseers", to deal with offences in doctrine and life. Their sanctions:

- admonition, once, twice and three times;
- for the obstinate, being "quietly" warned off the sacraments.

The order grounds the office on Christ's own institution in Matthew 18. **Kurpfalz, *Presbyterordnung*, about 1601** (Reformed; Sehling 14, p. 595):

[…] that by the presbytery or council of elders nothing else is to be understood than this: that beside the ministers of the church in every place certain particular persons are chosen yearly to be elders and overseers of the christian congregation, which in the stead of the whole congregation come together at certain times, as need requireth, and confer together how the offences which arise in doctrine and life in the congregation may be amended and done away; and also make admonitions out of the word of God, according to the order of the Lord Christ, the first, second and third time […] and, if one would wilfully continue in open sins and offence, warn him off from the holy sacraments quietly, with christian discretion, until he promise and shew amendment. Now that this order is grounded in God's word, and that Christ himself hath ordained and commanded it, the following sayings of holy scripture clearly shew.

These elders take a handfast vow (*angeloben*) to the published order. They are "confirmed" and announced from the pulpit on New Year's Day, then "confirmed through the common christian prayer". There is no laying on of hands. **Kurpfalz, *Presbyterordnung*, about 1601** (Reformed; Sehling 14, p. 598):

[…] thou shalt cause them to vow by handfast, and so confirm them and receive them under obligation. Afterward they shall be proclaimed to the congregation from the pulpit on New Year's day, and confirmed through the christian common prayer, with diligent admonition that every man acknowledge them for orderly elders and governors of the congregation, hold them in due honour, and render them obedience.

Hanau-Münzenberg (1609) (Reformed) copies this procedure. It adds that the minister must teach the congregation "that the office of elders is of God". This is said partly to comfort the elders, partly so that the people will not "exempt themselves" from their rebukes. **Hanau-Münzenberg, *Presbyteriumsordnung*, 1609** (Reformed; Sehling 10, p. 508):

[…] shall be taken under handfast vow. Whereupon on the following Sunday after a short sermon the elders shall be proclaimed again to the congregation, and so, after diligent admonition made that every man acknowledge them for orderly elders and governors of the congregation, hold them in due honour and render them obedience, be confirmed through the christian common prayer. But at such proclamation and confirmation it is needful that the minister of the church shew the congregation plainly out of the word of God, 1. that the office of elders is of God, from the testimonies of holy scripture set down above: for the elders' good, that they may take such office upon them as a divine calling […]; next, for the congregation's sake, that they set not themselves against such office nor exempt themselves from it […]

Pfalz-Veldenz (1574) calls its elders "censors". They are presented to the assembled congregation, "commended" from the pulpit with prayer and "set into this high office", "as we see that the apostles ordained the Elders and commended them to the congregation, Acts 14; likewise also the Deacons, Acts 6". **Pfalz-Veldenz, *Kirchenordnung*, 1574, "Order of the elders"** (Sehling 18, p. 573):

Those which are chosen to this high office shall thereafter, upon a set day when the congregation is assembled together (which also shall be admonished to appear diligently and to call upon God), be called and set before the congregation, and so publicly

with prayer from the pulpit by the Pastor be commended to the whole Congregation and set into this high office [...] even as we see that the apostles ordained the Elders and commended them to the congregation, Acts 14; likewise also the Deacons, Acts 6.

Solms (1594) (Reformed), in the discipline order of Count Johann Albrecht of Solms-Braunfels, binds its elders by an **oath**, "so help us God and his only Son", to watch over all offence and idolatry. They are to admonish offenders and, if admonition fails, report them to the proper authority. **Solms, *Kirchenzuchtordnung*, 1594, "The elders' oath"** (Reformed; Sehling 9, p. 338):

We swear and vow that, according to the tenor of our high office, we will have diligent oversight upon all offensive dealing in the church, all idolatry, blasphemy, levity and other things which strive against the honour of God and the holy gospel; that we will hinder the same so far as is possible for us, and admonish the transgressors, howsoever the occasion may be, to a better life; but if such admonition will not profit, that without envy, hatred, friendship [or] enmity we will bring such impenitent dealing to the proper place, and from thence await help, counsel and support [...] so help us God and his only Son.

Similar sworn **censors** are found in the **Wild- and Rhinegraviate** (1603). They are chosen by the pastor and the old censors and confirmed "under oath" by the superintendent and officials (Sehling 19/2, p. 600).

Nassau-Dillenburg (1582) (Reformed) counts the seniors as the third of the four offices. They are elected by the presbytery and confirmed by the classis (§16.5.3).

16.6.4 The Bohemian Brethren: lay presbyters and *presbyterae*

The Bohemian Brethren (Hussite) have lay *presbyteri politici*. These are "political presbyters" or "censors of manners", who oversee the life of the congregation and sit in a place of honour in church. The men of the congregation elect them by free vote after a visitor's admonition. They bind themselves "by voice and by hand given" to the bishops, the pastor and the church. The same is done for the **women elders** (*presbyterae*), with only women present. There is **no laying on of hands**. **Bohemian Brethren, *Ordo ecclesiasticus*, 1576, "Presbyterorum politicorum ordinatio"** (Bohemian Brethren; Sehling 4, p. 289):

The ordination of presbyters, when there is need, is performed with this rite. All the men are bidden to present themselves early before the evening sermon; and there, an admonition having first been given by the visitors, they choose by free votes those whom they judge worthy of that office. Those therefore which are designated by the most votes are called forth by the visitor when the evening sermon is ended, and the duties of this office are read to them (the whole assembly hearkening); and they bind their faith and diligence by voice and by hand given to the bishops of the unity, to the pastor, and to their church. And that they may also discharge the office of overseers in the church, they are honoured with a peculiar place of sitting (for the more convenient view of the people). The like is done when presbyteresses are chosen, except that the matter is performed with the female sex alone present.

Like the acolytes (§16.3.4), these presbyters are said to be "ordained", but by a handfast vow alone. This sets them clearly apart from the deacons and ministers, on whom hands are laid (§16.5.3).

16.6.5 The Lutheran orders: churchwardens and clerical seniors

Churchwardens. In the Lutheran orders the lay officers of the parish are the churchwardens, called *Kirchenväter* (churchwardens), *Kirchgeschworene* (church jurors), *Kastenherren* (chest-wardens) or *Kirchenpfleger* (churchwardens). They administer church goods, buildings and alms, often with the council. They are not given spiritual jurisdiction. Memmingen's discipline order (1532, Moderate Reformed) does give its *Kirchenpfleger* a wide advisory role over worship, schools, alms and the ban. But it expressly denies them any temporal jurisdiction, "so that two temporal authorities arise not again in our city". **Memmingen, *Zuchtordnung*, 1532** (Moderate Reformed; Sehling 12, p. 248):

For we give such churchwardens no temporal jurisdiction in our city, neither think to give [any] hereafter, to the end that two temporal authorities arise not again in our city [...]

Dinkelsbühl's twelve *Kirchenpfleger* fill their own vacancies "together with the pastor, who shall bring the Bible or the church order with him" (*Kirchenpflegeordnung*, 1574; Sehling 12, p. 131). In Augsburg the *Vergleichsartikel* of 1591 provide six *Kirchenpfleger* of the Augsburg Confession: three appointed by the council and three chosen by the evangelical citizens. They take part in the examination of new ministers (Sehling 12, pp. 109–110). The orders give no rite of installation for any of these wardens.

Clerical seniors. Where Lutheran orders speak of *seniores*, they usually mean **senior clergy**:

- In Brandenburg-Ansbach each dean, with the counsel of the whole chapter, chooses "two seniors, the fittest among all his subordinates", as assessors and definitors. They administer the superintendency in a vacancy and join him in visitation (*Kapitelsordnung*, 1565/78; Sehling 11, pp. 347, 350).
- Pomerania and the Silesian duchies (Liegnitz) use *seniores* in the same sense. The Pomeranian synod of 1574 bids the younger ministers honour the *seniores*, and has the superintendent punish unruly ministers with the counsel of the provosts and seniors (Sehling 4, p. 489).

"Elders" meaning the pastors. The ordination rite of the Erbach church order (1560) reads Titus 1:5 of the pastors themselves. Christ commanded his apostles "to choose and set elders in all his congregations, which shall preach his gospel pure and unfalsified, dispense the most worthy sacraments, and diligently provide and perform all cure of souls and shepherd's service". **Erbach, *Erbacher Kirchenordnung*, 1560, ordination rite** (Sehling 9, p. 446):

[…] and also commanded his own through his Apostles to choose and set Elders in all his congregations, which shall preach his Gospel pure and unfalsified, dispense the most worthy Sacraments, and diligently provide and perform all cure of souls and shepherd's service.

No ruling elders in the Lutheran orders. In short, a Lutheran order that speaks of "elders" is speaking of the pastors, of the senior pastors, or of the churchwardens. The **ruling elder** with a share in the power of the keys belongs to the Bucerian and Hessian (Moderate Reformed) and the Reformed orders.

The oaths of churchwardens and stewards are treated in Chapter 13, §13.12.4.

16.7 Sacristans, altar care, deaconesses and the religious life

This section treats six groups that stood beside the clergy without being clergy:

- the **sacristan**, who kept the vessels, vestments and font (§16.7.1);
- the people who cared for the **altar**, the nearest thing in the corpus to an altar guild (§16.7.2);
- **deaconesses** and the women who served the sick (§16.7.3);
- **monks** (§16.7.4) and **nuns** (§16.7.5);
- **beguines**, **tertiaries**, the **Brethren of the Common Life** and the lay **confraternities** (§16.7.6).

How each of them was received or installed is set out with the full forms in Chapter 13 §§13.12.2 and 13.12.6–13.12.10, and summarised in the table of §16.8 below.

16.7.1 Sacristans

No separate office. No evangelical order has a sacristan distinct from the sexton. The medieval sacristan (*sacrista*, *custos*, *Sigrist* [sexton], *Mesner* [sexton]) and the bell-ringer, sweeper and doorkeeper were one lay servant, called *Küster* (sexton), *Custos*, *Kirchner*, *Glöckner* (bell-ringer), *Opfermann* (sexton), *Mesner* or *Sigrist* according to region. The porter's keys passed to him (§16.3.5). So did the sacristan's charge: the chalices, the vestments and linen, the font and its water, the bread and wine, and the lights. In most villages he was also the schoolmaster.

Anhalt 1594: the sacristan's duties (Philippist). The appointment of the sexton of Törten in Anhalt is printed by Sehling as a "sexton's ordinance". It lists the sacristan's work with the rest: ringing, singing, opening and shutting the church, sweeping, "preparing the altar and font", and "vesting and unvesting the pastor". The post was granted for one year at a time. **Anhalt, *Ordnung für den Küster zu Törten*, 8 November 1594** (Philippist; Sehling 2, pp. 579–580):

The sexton shall not only perform in general, with highest and faithful diligence, all that pertaineth and belongeth to him in ringing, singing, opening and shutting the church, sweeping, preparing the altar and font, [and] vesting and unvesting the pastor, nothing excepted; but also in particular every day in the week, as is customary in schools, before and after noon, two hours each time […] keep school for boys and maidens (the harvest excepted) […] all on pain of losing the service, which shall be promised to every sexton for one year only; and he shall be bound, shortly before Michaelmas, to sue anew for it with the pastor.

The keeper of the vessels. Because the vessels and vestments were in his keeping, the sexton had to be of known honesty or give surety. **Sayn, *Kirchenordnung*, 1590** (Sehling 19/1, p. 438):

Forasmuch also as the chalices, the church's ornaments and other things which are to be kept in the church are entrusted to the bell-ringers, none shall be received as bell-ringer unless he be well known or have a warrantor or surety; that if anything be taken away from the church through his negligence or unfaithfulness, the church may recover the loss suffered again from him.

The Heidelberg bell-ringer of 1572 (Reformed) likewise received "the cloths, silver and vessels for the Supper and baptism" by inventory (Chapter 13 §13.12.2).

At the altar and the font. The sacristan's liturgical tasks recur across the orders:

- **The sick.** In Hohenlohe the pastor called to the sick takes "with him, together with his sexton, the particles, chalice, corporal, surplice" (Sehling 15, p. 73). Württemberg's German-school order of 1559 bids schoolmasters who also held the *Meßnerei* (sexton's office) go with the pastor to the sick "and carry the chalice" (Sehling 17/1, p. 585).
- **The font.** The Lippe sexton was to "fill the font often with clean, fresh water" (Sehling 21, p. 447). Baden in 1601 told the *Sigristen* to bring fresh water, "yet not too cold", and not to let it stand for weeks in the font (Sehling 16, p. 551).
- **Bread and wine.** Veit Dietrich forbade pastors to set hosts and wine on the altar without measure and leave the rest "to the sexton for his use at home" (Sehling 11, p. 531). In the Schönburg lordships in 1542 the sexton was no longer to buy the communion wine with his own money; the church was to pay and he to fetch it (Sehling 2, p. 176).

Not women. At Heilbronn in 1543 the council reserved the sacristan's office at the font to the sexton, and forbade it to women and maids, lest "the holy act of baptism be mocked by wicked people". **Heilbronn, *Kirchenordnung*, 1543** (Sehling 17/1, p. 315):

Moreover an honourable, wise [and] provident council will have it that the sextons, and not women or maids, open and shut the font, or reach the towel to the pastor [and] his deacon to dry the hands; but he shall do it himself, that the holy act of baptism be not mocked by wicked people.

The old abuses. The sacristan's access to the font water and the hosts made him suspect of the old "sorcery". Electoral Saxony in 1580, copied by Brandenburg-Ansbach in 1594 (Sehling 11, p. 391), ordered the pastors to stop it. **Electoral Saxony, *Kirchenordnung* of Elector August, 1580** (Sehling 1, p. 426):

Forasmuch as in some places there yet remaineth of the papistical sorcery, that the bell-ringers sell the baptismal water left over, as also some deal in the hosts left over, which are afterward used for sorcery, the pastors shall earnestly admonish the bell-ringers thereof, that they put it away; and if it happen again afterward, it shall be sharply punished.

Appointment. The sacristan was appointed, not ordained. In Strasbourg (1531, Moderate Reformed) the vacant offices of "helpers or *Sigristen*" were filled "by the pastors and parish churchwardens, and not otherwise" (Sehling 20/1, p. 226). Elsewhere the council, the patron or the pastor with the parish chose him, and he bound himself by pledge, oath or written *Revers* (pledge) (§16.8).

In the convents. The one sacristan with a distinct title is a woman: the **custorin** among the "spiritual or church offices" of the evangelical convent of Keppel (§16.7.5).

16.7.2 Altar care: no altar guild

No guild. The corpus knows no altar guild: no society of women or laymen charged with washing the altar linen, baking the hosts or adorning the altar. The care of the altar fell to three others:

- the **sexton** or sacristan (§16.7.1);
- the **lay churchwardens**, deacons of the chest or *Altarleute*, who bought the bread, wine and candles and kept the church's ornaments;
- in the convents, the sisters who held the church offices (§16.7.5).

The deacons of the church keep the altar. The Pomeranian synodal statutes of 1574 charge the lay *diaconi ecclesiae et pauperum* (deacons of the church and of the poor; §16.5.2) with the altar and its ornaments. **Pomerania, *Statuta synodica*, 1574** (Sehling 4, p. 491):

Let the pastors also watch that the deacons neglect not the fabric of the church, but that in the churches they keep the altar with its ornament, the pulpit, the font, the seats, and all things honestly and decently, and take care that the churchyards be honestly

fenced.

In Pfalz-Neuburg it was the churchwardens who received a florin "for the buying of hosts and wine" (Sehling 13, p. 208).

The confraternities dissolved. Before the Reformation the lights and adornment of many altars were kept by lay confraternities. These were dissolved, and their goods went to the common chest. The first such order, Leisnig's, names the brotherhoods of the Kaland, of St Anne and of the shoemakers' journeymen. **Leisnig, *Ordnung eines gemeinen Kastens*, 1523** (Sehling 1, p. 599):

Whatsoever in ready money, bought rents, jewels, silver plate, stores and movable goods hath been gathered hitherto for the said brotherhoods, of the Kaland, of St Anne and of the shoemakers' journeymen, and belongeth to the same, together with the deeds, inventories and registers, is altogether cast into and ordained for this common chest, there to remain.

Women at the altar. No order gives women a role at the altar. Heilbronn forbade them even to open the font or hand the towel (§16.7.1).

16.7.3 Deaconesses, sick-women and *Seelfrauen*

The word. The word *diaconissa* (deaconess) occurs once in an order of the corpus, at Keppel in 1570, for the sister "who distributeth the alms" (§16.7.5). There is no order of deaconesses and no rite for them. But three kinds of women did work that the early Church had given to deaconesses and widows:

- the **convent almoner** at Keppel;
- the **women elders** (*presbyterae*) of the Bohemian Brethren (Hussite), elected by the women of the congregation and bound by handfast vow (§16.6.4);
- the **sick-women** (*Seelfrauen*, *Krankenwärterinnen*), appointed by the council or the pastor to nurse and comfort the sick and dying. Some had been beguines.

Keppel 1570: the deaconess as almoner. Nassau-Dillenburg, *Ordnung für das Kloster Keppel*, 1570 (Sehling 10, p. 141):

The spiritual or church offices are: the lecturess or prioress; the precentress; the deaconess, that is, she who distributeth the alms; […] the catechists; […] the sacristaness. The temporal offices are: the cellaress, the church-mistress, the kitchen-mistress, the granary-mistress, she that keepeth the plate, [and] they that teach the children to sew, embroider and weave […]

The *Seelfrauen*. In the Franconian and Bavarian towns the *Seelfrauen* were the inmates of the *Seelhäuser* (soul-houses), foundations for poor widows and single women who nursed the sick and prayed for the dying (Sehling 11, p. 320, editors' note). The orders kept them, but under the pastor and the word:

- **Brandenburg-Ansbach 1536.** The visitors asked for oversight "of the *Seelfrau* and other such women who may serve the sick", that they serve for a reasonable wage (Sehling 11, p. 320).
- **Regensburg 1543.** The order appointed *Seelfrauen*, and men also, to attend the sick and dying, and prescribed what they were to say. **Regensburg, *Kirchenordnung des Noppus*, 1543** (Sehling 13, p. 410):

That besides there be appointed *Seelfrauen*, and men also, who shall let themselves be used for the sick where they are desired, and attend upon the dying. And such shall have a christian understanding, that they point the dying to the merit of Christ alone, not to their own merit or the intercession of the saints; [that they] say the Lord's Prayer and the Creed before them, and, where there is time, well-grounded psalms and songs, as: *Aus tiefer Not schrei ich zu dir* (Out of deep distress I cry to thee), etc., *In Fried und Freud ich fahr dahin* (With peace and joy I depart), *Nun freut euch, lieben Christen gmein* (Now rejoice, dear Christians together), [the hymns] of baptism [and] of the sacrament of the body and blood, etc.; not old, erroneous prayers and sayings.

- **Nördlingen 1544.** Kaspar Löner asked that the women whom the council had appointed to tend the sick be sent to him, so that he might examine their faith and understanding and teach them what they did not know (Sehling 12, p. 315). Sehling's editors note that this had been the task of the *Seelnonnen* of the town's beguine house, closed in 1536.
- **Wolfstein 1574.** Women who served the sick were to visit them often (Sehling 13, p. 582); the editors compare the Nuremberg *Seelfrauen*.

Beguines turned sick-visitors. Heilbronn in 1531 gathered its beguines into one house and charged them, as their service, to visit the sick and instruct them by God's word (§16.7.6).

Hospital nurses. The later Reformed orders put the sick-nurse under the hospital master. The Heidelberg hospital order of 1594 (Reformed) lets the hospital master engage "fit sick-nurses" (*kranckenwärterin*) and dismiss them for misconduct, with the advice of the inspectors, preacher, physician and surgeon (Sehling 19/2, p. 827). Here the office is a domestic service, without any churchly character.

16.7.4 Monks

Profession ended. Every evangelical territory ended new professions. The monks were offered three choices:

- to leave, marry or take up a trade, with their goods or a pension;
- to stay for life in a house set apart for them, with maintenance;
- in a few great abbeys, to live under an evangelical rule as teachers and students for the ministry.

Württemberg 1535. The first Württemberg monastery order forbade all new admissions, to the monasteries and to the houses of beguines and Lollards alike, and sent the unprofessed novices home. **Württemberg, *Klosterordnung*, 1535** (Sehling 16, p. 79):

Henceforth also no persons shall be received into the cloisters, nor likewise into the houses of the beguines and Lollards. And where there be now novices which have not yet made profession, they shall be sent home to their parents or kinsfolk without delay, with reasonable provision for the way.

Those who left received back what they had brought in, or forty florins a year for life. The few remaining mendicant friars were gathered into one house, the old and weak to be cared for "that they may so die in peace" (Sehling 16, pp. 79–80). In 1552 Duke Christoph forbade the abbots to "entangle" boys with "superstitious ceremonies and vows" to remain in the cloister (Sehling 16, p. 199).

Esslingen 1535: the friars who stayed (Moderate Reformed). Esslingen's order for the remaining Franciscans let any friar marry with a settlement from the council. Those who stayed received board and a yearly allowance. **Esslingen, *Ordnung für die Konventualen im Barfüßerkloster*, 6 September 1535** (Moderate Reformed; Sehling 17/2, p. 382):

Whosoever among the persons of the order would betake himself to another honest, christian estate and enter into the estate of matrimony, which shall be permitted to every one to undertake to the praise of God and the health of his soul, the same shall be set out and provided for by an honourable council, as the magistrate, according to the revenue of each cloister, with reasonable maintenance, as it shall please an honourable council. And those persons of the order which come not out, but purpose so to remain in the cloister, shall be provided with reasonable sustenance; and to him that hath been a priest ten florins, and to a lay brother five florins, shall be given every year for clothing and other bodily necessity.

Evangelical monasteries. Where the princes kept the great abbeys, they kept them as schools for the ministry. Their "conventuals" and "novices" were students under an evangelical abbot:

- **Württemberg.** At Herrenalb in 1556 the first Lutheran abbot agreed statutes by which "the conventuals and novices" were to pray morning and evening a Latin prayer for the church, the emperor, the duke and the abbot, and to live under discipline and study (Sehling 16, p. 317). The installation of the Württemberg prelates is in Chapter 13 §13.11.3.
- **Pfalz-Simmern.** At the Augustinian house of Ravengiersburg in 1560 no novice or prebendary was to be received without the duke's and the prior's knowledge. The young men were to be trained for the preaching office, and the convent might sing in Latin. **Pfalz-Simmern, *Klosterordnung Ravengiersburg*, 1560** (Sehling 19/2, p. 658):

Further also no youth or prebendary shall be received without the knowledge and will of us, Duke George, as prince of the land, and of me, the Father [prior]; and such young lords and scholars as are now already in the cloister, or shall hereafter be received with our knowledge as aforesaid, shall be taught, directed and held earnestly to this end, that they may hereafter in our principality hold and administer the preaching office or some other honourable church service for which they are found apt.

No vows. None of these houses required a vow. Ravengiersburg's scholar who was sent to the university bound himself only to serve the duke and the house (Sehling 19/2, p. 658).

16.7.5 Nuns

The women's houses survived longest. Many nunneries, above all the noble foundations of the north, survived the Reformation as evangelical convents or *Stifte*. They became homes and schools for unmarried women, keeping a rule, a habit of sorts, the hours in German or Latin, and an elected head (abbess, prioress or *domina*). The orders reformed them on four points:

- **Admission.** No one was to be clothed without the prince's or council's consent. At Goslar's convent of Frankenberg (1542) and in Württemberg no one was to be admitted at all.
- **Vows.** The vows of perpetual chastity and the cloister were not binding. A sister might leave and marry with her goods.
- **Habit.** The consecrated habit (cowl, scapular, veil and crown) was abolished or made optional. Baptism was declared the true clothing.
- **Worship.** The hours and the Mass were reformed. Daily preaching, the catechism and schooling for girls were added.

Goslar 1542: no new nuns, free to marry. Goslar, *Ordnung für das Frauenkloster Frankenberg*, 1542 (Sehling 7/2.2, p. 275):

5. They shall admit no persons hereafter to the habit of their order; but those which have not yet made profession they shall send away from them, with all that they brought to the convent. 6. It shall be free and lawful to every person of the convent either to remain in the convent all the time of her life, or to enter into matrimony with some honest man.

Lüneburg 1574: clothing kept, the habit changed. The Lüneburg houses still received girls, but under the duke's control. The cowl, scapular, veil and crown were replaced by a plain black or white gown. **Lüneburg, *Klosterordnung* of Duke William the Younger, 1574** (Sehling 6/1, p. 622):

So also no child or maiden shall be clothed without our foreknowledge and command. And whereas the cowls and scapulars and veils and the cross upon the head, as the persons of the cloister now wear them, give offence to many godly Christians […] henceforth no maiden shall be clothed in cowl and with veil and cross; but they shall wear honest black or white gowns of one fashion and cloth, and upon the head white kerchiefs, as they now have, without side-bands or wrought hoods, but no veil or cross. […] Also no person of the cloister shall be buried in cowl, scapular, veil, etc., but in a linen sheet like other Christians.

Mecklenburg 1572: baptism the true clothing. The Mecklenburg convent order of 1572 rejects the blessing of the habit "with certain little prayers" and holy water, and the "superstitious little books of consecration". **Mecklenburg, *Klosterordnung*, 1572** (Sehling 5, p. 254):

Likewise it is a superstitious error that the cloister garments, or cowls, scapulars and veils, consecrated with certain little prayers and sprinkled with holy water, should be spiritual and more glorious garments than others, whereby they cover their sins before the face of God and are preserved against the assault of the devil as with a harness, put on Christ, and become Christ's bride and queens; whereas all Christians alike are clothed in baptism in one spiritual garment, [and] put on the Lord Jesus Christ […]

On vows the same order teaches that "there is no higher vow than that which we have made in holy baptism", and that vows against God's command are not to be kept (Sehling 5, p. 255). Brunswick-Wolfenbüttel in 1569 argues the same at length. In baptism all Christians are clothed "in a red cowl, which is the most holy rose-coloured blood of our Lord Jesus Christ" and crowned, so that the sister who lays aside her habit and crown loses nothing (Sehling 6/1, pp. 324–326). The form of words for laying it aside is in Chapter 13 §13.12.10.

Admission by the magistrate. Strasbourg in 1555 took admission to its remaining women's houses out of the hands of the prioress. The council was to decide, and no girl was to be received under eight years old (Sehling 20/1, p. 454).

Keppel 1570: an evangelical clothing. The fullest evangelical form for receiving a nun is the Nassau order for the convent of Keppel. It has the following elements:

- a probation of at least two years;
- questions to the parents, the *domina* and the candidate;
- an oath;
- a sermon;
- the clothing in the sacristy;
- *Veni Sancte Spiritus* (Come, Holy Spirit) and an exhortation at the altar;
- the *Te Deum* (We praise thee, O God).

The exhortation tells the new sister that her vows earn nothing, that the convent is "not a prison" but "as it were a school", and that she may marry in an orderly way. The full rite is in Chapter 13 §13.12.7.

The offices of the convent. Keppel divides the sisters' offices into "spiritual or church offices" and "temporal offices" (quoted in §16.7.3):

- *Spiritual.* The lecturess or prioress, the precentress, the deaconess or almoner, the catechists and the sacristaness (*custorin*).
- *Temporal.* The cellaress, the church-mistress (*kirchenmeisterin*), the kitchen-mistress, the granary-mistress, the keeper of the plate and the needlework teachers.

The *domina* assigned these offices. She herself was proposed by the convent from two or three names, confirmed by the count and deposable by him, and swore an oath (Sehling 10, pp. 141–142).

Abbess and prioress. In Schleswig-Holstein the abbess of Itzehoe and the prioresses of the other houses were still elected by the convent "according to old custom", under oath in the provost's presence. The sisters swore obedience to them (Sehling 23, p. 182). At Strasbourg the "mother or prioress" and six elder "council-mothers" were chosen and gave a promise (Sehling 20/1, p. 456). Both forms are in Chapter 13 §13.12.8.

16.7.6 Beguines, tertiaries, Brethren of the Common Life and confraternities

Semi-religious communities. The orders say little about the beguines, the tertiaries of the mendicant orders, the *Nollharden* or Lollards (lay brothers who nursed the sick and buried the dead), and the Brethren and Sisters of the Common Life. What they say is of three kinds:

- the houses were closed to new members;
- the existing members were maintained or bought out;
- the communities were turned to the service of the sick or the school.

No order creates a third order or a lay religious community.

Closed to new members. Württemberg's order of 1535 shut the "houses of the beguines and Lollards" with the monasteries (§16.7.4). The beguines might keep or divide what they had brought in, and sell the houses they had built themselves, with the duke's knowledge (Sehling 16, p. 80). Sehling's editors record four houses of tertiary sisters at Reutlingen before the Reformation (Sehling 17/2, p. 28, editors' introduction). In Württemberg only the Franciscan tertiaries of Weiler used their right to emigrate, and went as a community to a convent near Augsburg (Sehling 16, p. 50, editors' introduction).

Heilbronn 1531: beguines as visitors of the sick. Heilbronn gathered its beguines into one house and gave them a service, which comes closest in the corpus to an evangelical diaconate of women. **Heilbronn, *Instruktion zur Zusammenlegung beider Beginenhäuser*, 8 December 1531** (Sehling 17/1, p. 298):

Item, when they shall so dwell together, they shall be willing upon request to go to the sick, and to instruct the sick according to God's word. Item, a council trusteth that they, considering that a good appearance becometh them, will not […] cleave to a distinct clothing, but otherwise clothe themselves honestly, and go diligently to hear the word of God.

Herford: the Brethren of the Common Life. Herford had both a brothers' and a sisters' house of the Common Life, and its Brethren were early supporters of the Reformation (Sehling 21, p. 160, editors' introduction). Its church order of 1532 nonetheless counted the separate communion of such houses as sectarian. **Herford, *Kirchenordnung*, 1532** (Sehling 21, pp. 173–174):

That is surely not called *convenire* [to come together], when one separateth oneself from the congregation into brothers' houses, sisters' houses and other factions and sects; but [it is] to gather with the common Christians to the remembrance of the Lord, to the use of the sacrament.

Confraternities. The lay brotherhoods (*Bruderschaften*) and the Kalands, which had kept altars, lights and anniversary Masses, were dissolved and their goods put into the common chest from Leisnig in 1523 onward (§16.7.2). Lemgo in 1537 gave the revenues of the brotherhoods and of the Kaland of Corpus Christi to the schoolmaster and preachers (Sehling 21, p. 302). Nassau in 1537 kept a common meal for its clergy synod, but without the "disorderly feasting … as hitherto at the Kalands" (Sehling 10, p. 84).

The answer in brief. The Reformation in the Sehling corpus kept no third order and founded none. It turned the surviving beguines and *Seelfrauen* (soul-women) into nurses of the sick under the pastor. The lay confraternities were dissolved into the common chest, and the Brethren of the Common Life were absorbed into the parish and the school.

16.8 Ordained or not: how each office was installed

Words that do not settle the question. "Ordain" (*ordiniren*, *ordinatio*) is not decisive in these texts:

- Lippe uses it of appointing deacons of the poor.
- The Bohemian Brethren (Hussite) use it of a handfast vow.
- Hesse (Moderate Reformed) uses it of a full rite with laying on of hands.

How the table classifies. The table below therefore classifies by what the rite actually does, in four degrees, from strongest to weakest:

- **hands**: laying on of hands, with prayer;
- **prayer**: public commendation with prayer, without hands;
- **vow**: a handfast vow (*Handgelübde*, *manu stipulata*) or an oath;
- **none**: appointment only.

Office	Order	Elected or appointed by	Installation	Section
Pastor or *Diaconus* (deacon; assistant minister)	Electoral Saxony 1580	Called by the church; examined; confirmed by the synod	**hands** (superintendent), prayer; "by divine command"	§16.5.1
Minister of the word	Pfalz-Zweibrücken 1539	Congregation	**hands** (neighbouring pastors or "elders")	§16.5.4
Minister of the word	Hesse 1566 (Moderate Reformed)	—	**hands** (superintendent, ministers **and elders**)	§16.6.2
Minister of the word	Nassau-Dillenburg 1582 (Reformed)	Classis and seniors	"confirmation or ordination", public	§16.5.3
Acolyte	Bohemian Brethren 1576	Pastor; examined by synod	**vow** (*manu stipulata*), right hand of fellowship, blessing	§16.3.4
Deacon (clerical)	Bohemian Brethren 1576	Chosen from acolytes; examined by seniors	**hands**, vow, prayer, blessing (Acts 6:6)	§16.5.3
Lay presbyter, *presbytera* (presbyteress)	Bohemian Brethren 1576	Free vote of the men (or women)	**vow** (*voce et stipulata manu*, by voice and by handfast); place of honour	§16.6.4
Deacon of the poor	Brunswick 1528, Hamburg 1529, Lübeck 1531	—	**none** described	§16.5.2
Diaconi (deacons)	Pyritz 1539	Council and guilds	**none**; "laden with no oath"	§16.5.2
Diaconi ecclesiae et pauperum (Deacons of the church and of the poor)	Pomerania 1574	Chosen under the pastors' eye	**vow** (oath)	§16.5.2
Leviten (levites; deacons of the poor)	Hadeln 1526	—	**none** described	§16.5.2

Office	Order	Elected or appointed by	Installation	Section
Subdiaconi oder Bittherren (Subdeacons or bidding-men)	Naumburg 1537	Council and community	**none** described	§16.5.2
Deacon of the poor	Hesse 1566 (Moderate Reformed)	Ministers with council and congregation; probation	**hands** and prayer (Acts 6)	§16.5.3
Deacon or almoner	Micron 1554/65 (Reformed)	Congregation	questions, prayer, **hands**	§16.5.3
Deacon or almoner	Kurpfalz 1563, Moers 1581, Bentheim-Tecklenburg 1588/1619 (all Reformed)	—; confirmed by pastors and seniors	confirmation, rite not described	§16.5.3
Deacon, senior, sexton	Nassau-Dillenburg 1582 (Reformed)	Presbytery; confirmed by classis	confirmation and admonition	§16.5.3
Lay elder	Hesse (Ziegenhain) 1539 (Moderate Reformed)	Each church	**prayer** and exhortation ("sanctify their office")	§16.6.2
Lay elder	Hesse 1566 (Moderate Reformed)	Ministers with council and congregation	**hands** (pastor and ministers), prayer; "ordained"	§16.6.2
Lay elder	Micron 1554/65 (Reformed)	Congregation	questions, prayer, **hands**	§16.6.3
Lay elder	Kurpfalz 1592 (also Ysenburg-Ronneburg 1592; both Reformed)	Congregation	questions, prayer, **hands** (minister and elders)	§16.6.3
Censor (elder)	Pfalz-Veldenz 1574	—	**prayer** from the pulpit; "set into this high office"	§16.6.3
Lay elder	Kurpfalz about 1601 (Reformed)	Yearly	**vow** (handfast), **prayer** of the congregation	§16.6.3
Lay elder	Hanau-Münzenberg 1609 (Reformed)	—	**vow** (handfast), **prayer**; "the office of elders is of God"	§16.6.3
Lay elder	Solms 1594 (Reformed)	—	**vow** (oath)	§16.6.3
Censor	Wild- and Rhinegraviate 1603	Pastor and old censors	**vow** (oath), confirmed by superintendent	§16.6.3
Churchwarden (*Kirchenpfleger*)	Strasbourg 1553	—	—	§16.6.1
Churchwarden	Memmingen 1532 (Moderate Reformed), Dinkelsbühl 1574, Augsburg 1591	Council (and citizens)	**none** described	§16.6.5
Sexton (*Opfermann*)	Hesse 1566 (Moderate Reformed)	Pastor and elders, with the superintendent	**none**	§16.3.5

Office	Order	Elected or appointed by	Installation	Section
Sexton and sacristan (*custos*)	Anhalt (Törten) 1594 (Philippist)	Prince's councillors with the superintendent; for one year, renewable at Michaelmas	**none**; written appointment	§16.7.1
Bell-ringer, keeper of the vessels	Sayn 1590	—; must be well known or give surety	**none**	§16.7.1
Sigrist (sexton)	Strasbourg 1531 (Moderate Reformed)	Pastors and parish churchwardens	**none** described	§16.7.1
Convent deaconess (almoner), sacristaness and other sisters' offices	Keppel 1570	Assigned by the *domina*	**none**	§16.7.3, §16.7.5
Seelfrau (sick-woman)	Regensburg 1543, Nördlingen 1544	Council; examined by the pastor (Nördlingen)	**none**	§16.7.3
Beguines as visitors of the sick	Heilbronn 1531	Council	**none**; troth "in place of an oath" to declare their goods	§16.7.6
Monk staying in the cloister	Württemberg 1535, Esslingen 1535 (Moderate Reformed)	—	**none**; no new professions	§16.7.4
Novice or scholar of an evangelical monastery	Ravengiersburg 1560	Duke and prior	**none**; no vow	§16.7.4
Nun	Keppel 1570	Count; parents, *domina* and candidate questioned	**vow** (oath with hand on breast), sermon, clothing, *Veni Sancte Spiritus* (Come, Holy Spirit), exhortation, *Te Deum* (We praise thee, O God)	§16.7.5
Nun	Lüneburg 1574	Duke's foreknowledge and command	clothing in a plain gown; rite not described	§16.7.5
Domina (prioress)	Keppel 1570	Convent proposes two or three; count confirms and may depose	**vow** (promise in place of oath); presented with an exhortation	§16.7.5
Abbess, prioress	Schleswig-Holstein 1610	Convent, sworn to choose well, in the provost's presence	**vow** (oath); the sisters swear obedience	§16.7.5
Mother (prioress) and six council-mothers	Strasbourg 1555	Chosen from the eldest and fittest	**vow** (promise)	§16.7.5

Summary. Laying on of hands was used for four groups:

- ministers of the word, everywhere;
- deacons of the poor, in Hesse 1566 (Moderate Reformed) and in Micron (Reformed);
- lay elders, in Hesse 1566 (Moderate Reformed), Micron and Kurpfalz 1592 (Reformed);
- the Bohemian Brethren's clerical deacons (Hussite).

It was not used for:

- sacristans, sick-women, nuns, convent heads or the scholars of the evangelical monasteries;
- Lutheran deacons of the poor or churchwardens;
- the Reformed elders of the Kurpfalz *Presbyterordnung*, Hanau or Solms, and the elders of Lutheran Veldenz;
- any minor grade, including the Bohemian acolytes.

Answer to the question asked. Were ruling elders ordained? Yes, in Hesse 1566 (Moderate Reformed), the London-Norden order of Micron and the Palatinate form of 1592 (both Reformed). Elsewhere they were installed with prayer, a handfast vow or an oath, and none of these used the language of ordination except Veldenz, which uses it of the apostles.

16.9 Women and laymen in the church's services

This section asks what women, and laymen who were not ministers, might do in the worship and offices of the church.

- **Women.** Could they be elders where there were elders, or churchwardens? Could they be lay deacons of the poor, as distinct from deaconesses (§16.7.3)? Which of the minor or lesser offices could they hold? Could they read in church, lead the prayers or bid them? Could they be cantors, sing in the choir or direct it?
- **Laymen.** Could they give the bread and the cup? Could they lead the prayers in church? Who read the bids of the prayers?

The answers come from the parish orders and from the orders for the evangelical women's convents. The convents gave women a liturgical part that the parish orders did not. Several related matters are treated elsewhere and only cited here:

- emergency baptism by midwives and other women: §13.3.7; the appointment of midwives: §13.12.5;
- the hours in the women's convents: §10.4.4, §10.8.2; the convent offices of Keppel: §16.7.5;
- girls' schools and schoolmistresses: §15.9.3; a girl leading the prayers in the Torgau girls' school: §10.12.7;
- the girls' choirs at Naumburg and Hof: §9.3.3, §2.6.1, §8.16.10, §10.11.4;
- the Litany and its singers: §10.12.3, §13.21;
- the communion cloth and who held it: §14.6.3;
- who said the general prayer: §6.1.2.

16.9.1 Summary of findings

Women

1. **The rule.** The orders read Paul's "let your women keep silence in the churches" (1 Corinthians 14:34; 1 Timothy 2:12) broadly:
    - Hesse in 1566 (Moderate Reformed) held that Paul forbade women not only to teach and preach but "all the actions of the church's service", the sacraments included. The Hessian *Agende* of 1574 (Philippist), Pfalz-Veldenz 1574 and Nassau-Weilburg 1576 repeat it.
    - Homberg 1526 (Moderate Reformed) let women attend the congregation's assembly, but "the men alone shall decide".
    - Württemberg in 1556 gave the rule as the reason why the women's convents, unlike the men's, could not be made schools for the church (§16.9.2).
2. **Elders: no.** The orders that say whom to choose as elders, censors or seniors ask for "honourable men". Where the congregation votes, the men vote. The one exception is the women elders (*presbyterae*) of the Bohemian Brethren (Hussite), chosen by the women for the women (§16.6.4). Women governed women only in the convents (§16.9.3).
3. **Churchwardens: no.** The churchwardens and keepers of the chest are "god-fearing men". The only woman with a warden's title is the "church-mistress" of the convent of Keppel (1570).
4. **Lay deacons: no.** The deacons of the poor were men. The nearest offices for women were:
    - the four "honourable widows and godly matrons" of the Emden hospital (1594, Reformed);
    - the convent's almoner (*diaconissa*) at Keppel;
    - the sick-women (§16.7.3);
    - the matrons who helped the Bohemian preacher examine the girls.
5. **The lesser offices.**
    - No minor order survived for anyone (§16.3).

- The sexton's work was kept from women. Heilbronn (1543) forbade them the font, and Hoya (1581) the church clock. Only the convents had a sacristaness: at Keppel (*custorin*) and at Fischbeck (*Küsterin*).
- The one parish office open to women was that of **schoolmistress** of the girls' school. She was appointed by the council or the visitors and paid by the council, the chest or the parents. She was bound to the church order, and visited for her conduct "in the church and school" together with the sextons and schoolmasters (Electoral Saxony 1577) (§16.9.4).

6. **Reading: not in the parish service, but in the convent choir.**
   - No parish order gives a woman a lesson to read.
   - In the convents the sisters read the lessons, chapters and collects themselves (Pfalz-Neuburg 1543, Württemberg 1556, Brunswick-Wolfenbüttel 1569, Mecklenburg 1572, Obernkirchen 1603).
   - Girls spoke in church as catechumens. In Honterus's Transylvanian order (1543) the schoolgirls put the catechism questions to one another "for the instruction of the hearers" (§16.9.5).
7. **Leading prayers: in the convents.** There the *domina*, and after her each sister for a week, led the Lord's Prayer, the versicles and the prayers (Mecklenburg 1572; Brunswick-Wolfenbüttel 1569). In the parish church no woman led the prayers.
8. **Bidding prayers: no.** The bids were the minister's. Women asked for the church's prayer, in childbirth and in sickness, and the minister announced it (§16.9.9).
9. **Cantors: only in the convents.** No parish order has a woman cantor. In the convents the *cantrix* or precentress began the antiphons and psalms and "ordered the singing in the choir" (Soest 1543; Keppel 1570) (§16.9.6).
10. **The choir.**
    - Women sang with the congregation, and were told to. Hoya (1581) commanded the women, maidens and maids who kept silent in church to "open their mouth" and sing.
    - In some towns the schoolgirls sang as a choir of their own, in alternation with the boys (Naumburg 1537/38, Hof 1592), or sang the whole German hymn (Dresden 1574).
    - At Schmalkalden (1555) they helped to sing the Litany, and Nördlingen (1555) hoped to train such a choir. Zwickau abolished its maidens' choir in 1529.
    - In the convents the sisters were the choir.
11. **Directing the choir.** In the parish church men led the girls' singing: the girls' schoolmaster, or at Hof the superintendent or the deacon of the week. Only the convent *cantrix* directed a choir as a woman.

Laymen

12. **The bread and the cup: the ministers'.**
    - The Lutheran orders give the bread and the cup to the pastor and his ordained deacon.
    - Hesse (1566, Moderate Reformed) let a senior, a keeper of the chest, a schoolmaster who studied theology, or the sexton help with the cup when the communicants were many, but "not a person of a worldly office".
    - Nassau-Weilburg in 1617 forbade laymen to serve the cup any longer.
    - In Micron's Reformed order the communicants passed the dishes of bread and the cups to one another along the table.
    - Laymen held the communion cloth: boys, honest men or the churchwardens (§16.9.7).
13. **Leading prayer: yes, in set forms, but not preaching.**
    - Schoolboys, the schoolmaster or the sexton sang the Litany (Regensburg 1542, Brunswick-Wolfenbüttel 1543, Steuerwald and Peine 1561).
    - In filial villages the sexton read the Sunday epistle and gospel, sang the hymns and read the catechism (Electoral Saxony 1557).
    - He closed with the collect when the preacher was absent (Kolberg 1586), and the schoolmaster held the daily prayer (Homburg 1605, Reformed).
    - But "no bell-ringer who is not examined and ordained" might preach (1557).
    - In Micron's London church, elders, deacons and "other able men" might speak in the "prophecy" (§16.9.8).
14. **The bids: the minister's.**
    - The pastor, deacon or chaplain read the exhortation to prayer and the bids, usually from the pulpit (Nördlingen 1555, Prussia 1568, Aschersleben 1575; §6.1.2).
    - The petitions of the Litany were the exception: boys or the sexton sang them.
    - Laypeople asked for prayers, by word or by a slip laid on the pulpit, and the minister read them out. Stendal (1578) had the council's notices read by the clergy, and kept "the town servants off the pulpit" (§16.9.9).

Who could do what

Office or act	Women in the parish	Women in the convents	Laymen
Elder, censor, senior	No; "honourable men" only (the Bohemian women elders excepted)	The *domina*, prioress and council-mothers govern the house	Yes, where there were elders (§16.6)
Churchwarden, keeper of the chest	No	Church-mistress (Keppel 1570)	Yes; "god-fearing men"
Deacon of the poor	No; matrons in the Emden hospital (1594, Reformed)	Almoner (*diaconissa*, Keppel 1570)	Yes (§16.5.2–16.5.3)
Sexton, sacristan	No: not at the font (Heilbronn 1543), not the clock (Hoya 1581)	Sacristaness (Keppel; Fischbeck)	Yes
Schoolmistress	Yes; appointed, paid and visited	Yes; chosen from the sisters (Soest 1543)	— (the schoolmaster)
Midwife	Yes; sworn, and may baptize in need (§13.12.5)	—	—
Reading the lessons	No	Yes	The sexton in filial churches; schoolboys at Vespers and the catechism
Leading the prayers	No (in the girls' school only, §10.12.7)	Yes; the *domina* and each sister by the week	The Litany, collects, daily prayer (sexton, schoolmaster, boys)
Bidding the prayers	No; women asked for the church's prayer	—	Only the Litany's petitions; requests handed to the minister
Cantor, precentor	No	*Cantrix*, precentress	Cantor and schoolmaster (§15.9)
Singing in the choir	With the congregation; girls' choirs in some towns	Yes; the whole convent	Yes; the school choir
Directing a choir	No; men led the girls	The *cantrix*	Cantor, schoolmaster
Giving the bread and the cup	No	No	No; help with the cup in Hesse 1566, ended in Nassau-Weilburg 1617; passed along the table (Micron)
Preaching	No	No; a preacher was appointed	No, unless examined and ordained

16.9.2 "Let your women keep silence": the rule

The Hessian reading of Paul. The orders seldom state the rule, because they seldom imagine the case. Where they do, it is in the section on emergency baptism, the one sacramental act that might fall to a woman. Hesse in 1566 (Moderate Reformed) begins that section with 1 Corinthians 14:34. Paul "will not that a woman speak in the congregation", and so he forbids women "without doubt all the actions of the church's service, and not only the teaching and preaching, but also the administration of the holy sacraments" (Sehling 8, p. 282). The Hessian *Agende* of 1574 (Philippist) recast the passage and added a reason: these acts had always belonged to men, in both Testaments. **Hesse, *Agende*, 1574** (Philippist; Sehling 8, pp. 428–429):

The apostle Paul saith [1 Cor. 14:34] that the women shall keep silence in the congregation; whereby he will have taken from them and forbidden not only the public teaching and preaching in the common Christian assemblies, but also the reaching of the sacrament, and the other actions and dealings belonging to the common service of the church, for which men have at all times been appointed, in both the Old and the New Testament. […] Therefore the midwives and other women shall be most

earnestly forbidden, and held thereto, that where the children happen to be weak they undertake not to baptize, but send for the minister, be it by day or by night.

Copied in Lutheran orders. The same passage stands, with small changes, in the Lutheran orders of Pfalz-Veldenz (1574), Nassau-Weilburg (1576) and the Corvey village of Bruchhausen (1603) (Sehling 18, p. 473; 10, p. 249; 21, p. 253). Pfalz-Veldenz first gives the Latin of 1 Corinthians 14:34 and 1 Timothy 2:12. It then forbids women "all the *Lectiones* of the church's service", that is, the lessons, where Hesse has *actiones*, the actions. So its text forbids women the readings in so many words. Hesse 1566 and Pfalz-Veldenz both cite:

- Tertullian's *De virginibus velandis* (On the veiling of virgins);
- Epiphanius on the Quintillians and the Collyridians, who "allowed women to perform the church's offices";
- the Fourth Council of Carthage, which forbade a woman to baptize.

The rule did not end emergency baptism. Neither order went as far as the Reformed Palatinate, which abolished emergency baptism by laypeople (§13.3.7). If the minister could not be had and "the highest need" was at hand, those present were to call upon God, pray the Lord's Prayer and baptize. The child was then "rightly and sufficiently baptized" (Hesse 1566, Sehling 8, p. 283; *Agende* 1574, p. 429). Those present at a birth were the midwife and the women. Sehling's editors note the tension in the 1566 order: its liturgical part presupposes emergency baptism by midwives, while its historical part denies it (Sehling 8, p. 282, note). The Lutheran orders kept the midwife's baptism without such reserve (§13.3.7, §18.4.1).

Homberg 1526: present, but silent. The Homberg synod (Moderate Reformed) made the assembly of the faithful the judge of the church's business. Women might attend it, but not speak. **Hesse, *Homberger Kirchenordnung*, 1526** (Moderate Reformed; Sehling 8, p. 52):

We ordain therefore that in every parish, after the word of the Lord hath been preached therein for some while, on every Lord's day, either straight after the Lord's Supper or after dinner, there be an assembly of the faithful in a fit place; to which as many of the men as favour the cause of Christ, and are held in the number of the saints, shall come together, that with the bishop they may determine out of the word of the Lord all things that fall to be dealt with in the church. […] At this the faithful women may indeed be present; but it is not permitted them to speak in the churches, 1 Cor. 14 and 1 Tim. 2. Therefore the men alone shall determine.

Württemberg 1556: no schools in the women's convents. Duke Christoph turned the men's monasteries into schools for the ministry (§16.7.4), but the women's houses could not follow. **Württemberg, *Ordnung für Frauenklöster*, 3 February 1556** (Sehling 16, p. 304):

Forasmuch as the women's convents, as they have hitherto been founded and used, have not been profitable to the common good of the church, nor can schools be set up therein for the understanding of the same (for according to the doctrine of Paul the women shall keep silence in the congregation, and it shall not be permitted them to speak, but to be in subjection)

A model of church order. Veit Dietrich's *Agendbüchlein* (agenda booklet; Nürnberg 1545), copied by Hohenlohe in 1553, gives Paul's rule as its example of a lawful church ordinance: "Paul commandeth that there be an order in the church with the reading and preaching, and forbiddeth the women that they should preach" (Sehling 11, p. 549; 15, p. 57). Hesse in 1566 sets it beside the rule of 1 Corinthians 11 on covered and uncovered heads (Sehling 8, p. 180).

16.9.3 Women and the offices of governance

Elders: men. The orders that say whom to choose as elders, censors or seniors ask for men:

- Rothenburg (1558) recalls that in the first church "certain elders, god-fearing, wise and valiant men" stood beside the ministers (Sehling 11, p. 610).
- Pfalz-Veldenz (1574) has six or so "honourable men" chosen in each parish to watch over "the common people, men and women" (below).
- The Wild- and Rhinegraviate (1603) has "seven or fewer honourable men" (Sehling 19/2, p. 600).
- Micron's London order (Reformed) admits to the "prophecy" only "god-fearing and able men" from the elders, deacons and congregation (§16.9.8).

Where the congregation votes, the men vote: at Homberg (1526, above), and among the Bohemian Brethren, where "all the men" elect the presbyters (§16.6.4). **Pfalz-Veldenz, *Kirchenordnung*, 1574** (Sehling 18, pp. 572–573):

In every parish six honourable men, more or fewer according to the occasion of the place and of the people, of good report and conversation, shall be chosen out of the congregation, appointed, and received with troth given by the hand in the stead of an oath; and charge shall be given them to have a diligent, faithful oversight of the discipline and honesty of the common people, men and women, young and old, without any respect of persons.

Women over women: the Bohemian matrons and the convents. The one parish order that gives women a part in oversight is that of the Bohemian Brethren. Besides the women elders (*presbyterae*, §16.6.4), matrons helped the preacher to examine the older girls on the sermon. **Bohemian Brethren, *Ordo ecclesiasticus*, 1576** (Hussite; Sehling 4, p. 282):

When the midday and the afternoon sermon is ended, the young men and the older girls remain, and are examined by the preacher (one of the presbyters helping him with the one, but matrons with the other), how attentive they have shown themselves that day in hearing the word of God, and how much each hath observed.

In the convents women governed women: the *domina* or prioress, chosen by the sisters, and at Strasbourg six "council-mothers" beside the prioress (§16.7.5). Even there the word and the sacrament came from outside. At Nimbschen and Remse (1533) no one but "their appointed preacher" was to preach to the maidens or hear their confession (Sehling 1, pp. 619, 652). At Salzwedel (1540) the chaplain was to preach to them on Sundays and Wednesdays, hear their confession, and give them the sacrament "as often as he is asked" (Sehling 3, p. 272).

Churchwardens: men. The wardens of the church's goods and the keepers of the chest were men:

- Lippe (1571) wants "god-fearing, honourable men, understanding and experienced in writing and reading" (Sehling 21, p. 449).
- Pomerania (1569) wants "god-fearing, understanding, upright men" as deacons of the chest (Sehling 4, p. 409).

The Transylvanian Saxons (1587) put it in one sentence. **Transylvania, *Gemeinsame Landesordnung*, 8 July 1587** (Sehling 24, p. 463):

that every year two upright men, well affected toward God and the holy office of preaching, shall be chosen out of the elders of the congregation to be church-fathers, to whom the goods of the church shall be handed over

The only woman with a warden's title is the "church-mistress" (*kirchenmeisterin*), among the temporal offices of the convent of Keppel (1570; §16.7.5).

Deacons of the poor: men, and matrons for the hospital. The lay deacons of the poor (§16.5.2–16.5.3) were men in every order. The Reformed church of Emden set women beside them in one place, the hospital (*Gasthaus*). **Emden, *Summarische beschryvinge der ordnung in der christlicken kercken to Embden*, 1594** (Reformed; Sehling 7/1, p. 505):

Besides that, four honourable widows and godly matrons are chosen, which take diligent heed to the beds and linen, the flax and what belongeth thereto, and set the women and maids to work; and for that purpose meet three times weekly in the hospital in their appointed place, and ask for what they need thereto; and once yearly visit the citizens from house to house for linen and other necessaries of the hospital, and especially of the orphans.

They were chosen, but the order does not call them deacons, and they kept house rather than gave alms. The almoner of Keppel was called *diaconissa* (deaconess), but she served her sisters (§16.7.3).

16.9.4 Women in the lesser offices: sexton, schoolmistress and midwife

Not the sexton's office. No parish order lets a woman do the sexton's work. Heilbronn in 1543 kept the font and the towel for the sexton, "and not women or maids" (§16.7.1). Hoya in 1581 forbade the sexton to leave the church clock to his household. **Hoya, *Kirchenordnung*, 1581** (Sehling 6/2, p. 1142):

Where there is a clock which is set by the sexton, the sexton shall see to it that he govern the works himself, evening and morning, and keep his wife and children from it; if not, and it be spoiled thereby and go wrong, he shall answer for it.

The sexton's wife worked beside him in another way. Lauenburg (1585) let the sextons keep German girls' schools in the small towns, with their wives teaching the needlework. **Lauenburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1585** (Sehling 5, p. 422):

But boys and maidens they may well teach in the villages, for the people's reasonable reward, to read and write and to pray the catechism. And in the small towns they shall be free to keep German schools for maidens, and, over and above the reading, writing and teaching of the catechism, to instruct them also in sewing, embroidering, weaving and the like through their wives.

In the convents the sacristan was a sister. Keppel (1570) had its *custorin* (§16.7.5). At the Stift of Fischbeck, Agnese von Mandelsloh was *Küsterin* from 1580 to 1582, and abbess from 1587 (Sehling 7/2.2, p. 81, editors' note).

The schoolmistress. The one parish office open to women was that of the girls' schoolmistress. She was not a church servant in the full sense. But she was chosen with the superintendent's or the pastor's knowledge, paid, bound to an order, and visited. At Schmalkalden in 1555 the visitors allowed a matron or an old man, and counted the Litany among the things the girls were to learn. **Schmalkalden, *Ordnung der Visitatoren*, 1555** (Sehling 2, p. 348):

Seventhly, an honourable council shall appoint a Christian and God-fearing matron, or an honest old man, to begin a school for maidens, with the foreknowledge of the superintendent and pastor; to instruct the maidens for a reasonable wage in the catechism, spiritual songs and psalms, to teach them to write and read, [and] to help to sing the Litany in the church.

At Cottbus in 1579 the visitors confirmed a widow in the office for life, and bound her to the general superintendent's printed order. **Cottbus, *Visitations-Abschied*, 1579** (Sehling 3, p. 201):

The maidens' school is provided for by Mistress Anna, widow of Master Georg Lehmann. So the lords visitors will have her made schoolmistress for good; and the schoolmistress shall henceforth keep to the order which Dr Andreas Musculus, general superintendent, hath caused to be put in print, and bring up the maidens committed to her in all discipline and honesty

The Saxon visitors of 1577 asked after her together with the church's other servants. **Electoral Saxony, *Visitations-Instruktion*, 1577** (Sehling 1, p. 350):

5. How the German schoolmasters, also the maidens' schoolmistress in the towns, and the sextons in the villages, each conduct themselves in their office in the church and school.

The same office appears in other forms:

- The Reformed Palatinate (1595) had "every schoolwoman" bring her girls to the catechism sermon (§15.9.3).
- Lauenburg (1585) wanted "honourable, unsuspected, Christian matrons" as schoolmistresses (Sehling 5, p. 446).
- At Stendal (1540) the girls' school was to be kept by "a woman, or one or more of the convent maidens of St Anne" (Sehling 3, p. 310).
- In the convents the sisters chose a schoolmistress from among themselves (Soest 1543, Sehling 22, p. 468), or a matron or maiden was engaged (Mecklenburg 1572, Sehling 5, p. 260).

The midwife. The midwife was the other woman whom the church examined and swore, because she might have to baptize (§13.12.5). Bugenhagen's Hamburg order of 1529 says that the midwives "may well be called church servants" (§16.2).

16.9.5 Women reading and praying aloud

In the parish church: not in the service. Under the Hessian rule (§16.9.2) no woman read or prayed aloud in the congregation, and no parish order gives her a reading. Girls spoke in church as catechumens: they said the parts of the catechism and the prayers at the catechism examinations (§10.12). At Regensburg the boys' and the girls' schools sang from the catechism together, but two boys did the questions and answers. **Regensburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1567(?)** (Sehling 13, p. 464):

First the schools, both boys and girls, sing something from the catechism, according to the part of it that is chiefly handled that day, as the Ten Commandments, or the Creed, or the Lord's Prayer, of baptism or of the Supper. Thereafter the preacher readeth from the pulpit a little piece of the methodical summary set forth, as it standeth hereafter. Upon that, two boys stand on stools prepared for this over against one another, of whom the one asketh and the other answereth

In Honterus's order for Kronstadt the schoolgirls took the part that fell to boys elsewhere. After Vespers they sang in the church, or put the catechism questions to one another before the congregation. **Transylvania, Honterus, *Reformationsbüchlein*, 1543** (Sehling 24, p. 184; Latin):

When all is done, the little schoolgirls either sing some little songs in the church, or put questions to one another on the chief parts of the catechism and explain them for the instruction of the hearers. Sometimes also one of the ministers pronounceth the

rudiments of the catechism to the youth.

The German version has "the taught maidens" (*dye gelerte meydleyn*) do the same (Sehling 24, p. 196). In the Torgau girls' school (1575) a girl led the prayers, but that was in school, not in church (§10.12.7).

In the convent choir: the sisters read and pray. In the evangelical convents the women kept their own office in the choir (§10.4.4), and the orders gave its readings and prayers to the sisters. Pfalz-Neuburg (1543) has the women of the convents "read their lessons, chapters and collects in German" (§10.8.2). In Württemberg (1556) one sister reads a chapter aloud, so that "the reader and the hearers" may profit. Both words are feminine. **Württemberg, *Ordnung für Frauenklöster*, 1556** (Sehling 16, p. 307), on the morning exercise:

There they shall first, for the entrance, sing together the Lord's Prayer or a German psalm out of the common psalm-book; and thereupon only two or three psalms from the beginning of the Psalter in its order, on two choirs one against the other; and thereupon one of them shall read a chapter in the Old Testament, all with right, understandable measure and with raised, loud voice, that the reader and the hearers may receive profit thereof

In Brunswick-Wolfenbüttel (1569) "one of the maidens" says the morning prayer "with a loud voice, for the others to pray with her", and then reads the chapter (Sehling 6/1, p. 260). In Mecklenburg (1572) the office goes round the convent by the week, beginning with the *domina*. **Mecklenburg, *Klosterordnung*, 1572** (Sehling 5, p. 257):

so that the *domina* the first week, and thereafter one after another, each a whole week, when they are assembled in the choir, shall read the appointed prayers and lessons, and at the beginning say before the others, with a loud voice, the prayer which our Lord and Saviour Jesus Christ himself hath prescribed to all Christians. Thereafter the maiden singeth: Lord, open thou my lips. Glory be to the Father and to the Son and to the Holy Ghost. Choir: That my mouth may shew forth thy praise.

The Schaumburg order for the Stift of Obernkirchen (1603) speaks of the sisters as administering their own service. **Schaumburg, *Ordnung für das Stift Obernkirchen*, 6 August 1603** (Sehling 7/2.2, p. 88):

How the maidens shall administer and perform their holy offices and their whole service in the church daily, and also on Sundays and other feasts […] At Matins: 1. In the morning, when the maidens are assembled in their choir, they shall with one accord and with devotion sing or pray the *Veni Sancte Spiritus* (Come, Holy Spirit). 2. Thereafter read with a loud voice certain German psalms out of the Psalter of David […] 5. Hereupon a collect [shall be] sung or spoken for the preservation of the spiritual and temporal government

Reading at table was the young sisters' task too. At Soest (1543) they read "one after the other" a lesson from the Old or New Testament at the midday and evening meals, appointed by the schoolmistress (Sehling 22, p. 468). At Spandau (1541) one of them read an article of the church order in the refectory (§10.4.4).

The limit was the sermon and the sacrament. The sisters read, sang and prayed, but a man was appointed to preach to them and give them the sacrament (§16.9.3). At Kolberg (1586), whose maidens lived on the convent's alms, even the collect fell to a man: the convent's preacher, or in his absence the sexton (§16.9.8).

16.9.6 Women singing, and who led the singing

With the congregation. The German hymn was for everyone. At Naumburg in 1527, after the priest had intoned the Creed, the whole congregation took it up in German. **Naumburg, *Kirchen-Ordnung für die St. Wenzelskirche*, 1527** (Sehling 2, pp. 59–60):

Straightway thereupon the whole church and assembly, of men, maidens and women, whoever can and will sing, beginneth to sing the Creed in German

The later orders complain when the women do not sing. **Hoya, *Kirchenordnung*, 1581** (Sehling 6/2, p. 1192):

Ninthly, it is found also that the women, maidens and maidservants, which elsewhere gladly sing worldly songs, keep silence in the church, or whisper secretly to themselves, and are ashamed to praise their God and Lord. Therefore we earnestly command them that they open their mouth, lift up their voice, and help to praise, thank and glorify God aloud; and that they see to it that they learn the psalms and spiritual songs of praise; and that those which can read bring their psalm-books with them into the church and sing out of them

At Münster in the Gregoriental (1578) the schoolmasters were to lead the singing so that "not only the scholars, but also the common people, men and women, can sing along" (Sehling 20/2, p. 394). At Schweinfurt the schoolmaster resisted. **Schweinfurt, editors' introduction** (Sehling 11, p. 622):

In the rebuilding, Pastor Wolfgang Ruprecht (1556–1563) also tried to reshape the church order by giving the congregation a more direct part in the service. He wanted to let them sing German songs. But the schoolmaster complained, asserting that "it belongeth to the school, and not … to the old women, to sing". The council took the schoolmaster's side, and allowed only that a German song be sung by the congregation on the three high feasts.

Girls' choirs. In some towns the schoolgirls sang as a choir of their own. Zwickau ended one in 1529. **Zwickau, *Verordnung der Visitatoren*, 1529** (Sehling 1, p. 722):

Also the office of the Mass and Vespers may be sung in Latin on high feasts. The maidens' choir with its singing shall cease, for there is no need to burden them with that labour.

Naumburg's St Wenzel order of 1537/38 counts four choirs "when the maidens also sing in choir" (§9.3.3). When Nördlingen took over the passage in 1555, it added that its girls' choir had still to be founded. **Nördlingen, *Ordnung der ceremonien*, 1544, revised 1555** (Sehling 12, p. 320):

But when the maidens also sing in the choir, whom in time, if God give grace, we will train thereto, four choirs are held

At the Dresden Kreuzkirche (1574) the girls and maidservants sang the whole German hymn before the midday sermon. **Dresden, *Gottesdienst-Ordnung der Kreuzkirche*, 1574** (Sehling 1, p. 555):

The midday sermon. About the eleventh hour after dinner the bell is rung for the sermon. The first verse of some German song is played on the organ; the girls and maidservants sing the whole German song, and the church singeth too, through all that hour from eleven until twelve.

Hof (1592) gives the fullest picture. Its girls' choir sang one acclamation of the Kyrie (§2.6.1), alternate verses of the German Magnificat (§10.11.4), and the German verses of the Latin festal songs (§8.16.10). The order also says who led the two choirs. **Hof, *Ordo ecclesiasticus*, 1592** (Sehling 11, pp. 428, 474):

At the evening prayers a hymn, or other godly song serving the season, is sung by two choirs, the one of the scholars, which the rector governeth, the other of the girls, the organist going before them; so that the boys sing the first verse or paragraph and the girls the second, and so on. […] First a Christian song […] is sung by two distinct choirs, in which the cantor with his boys performeth the first stanza, but the lord superintendent, or the deacon who is of the week, the second with the schoolgirls, and so on. When this song is ended, a scholar of the third class readeth a chapter out of the book of Jesus Sirach within the rails of the altar, with his face turned to the hearers

In the Whit Monday procession "the maidens' schoolmaster beside his schoolgirls and other maidens, and behind them the womenfolk" followed the men, singing *Sei Lob und Ehr mit hohem Preis* (Praise and honour be with high praise) "at the maidens' schoolmaster's beginning" (Sehling 11, p. 463). At Aschersleben (1575) the girls of the maidens' school were catechized at Vespers three days a week, while the sexton sang the German psalm (Sehling 2, p. 480).

The convent choirs and their precentresses. In the convents the sisters were the choir, and a sister led it. The order for St Walburgis at Soest (1543) makes the *cantrix* its director. **Soest, *Ordnung für das Kloster St. Walburgis*, 1543** (Sehling 22, p. 468):

Of the singer. The *cantrix* and her assistant shall begin the antiphons, psalms, hymns, etc., in the choir; and the *cantrix* shall order the singing in the choir according to the occasion of the season and of the maidens, to the most profitable and best. It is also our command that the maidens sing more German than Latin; and what they sing in Latin shall be well declared by the preacher, that they may know and understand what they sing. The same shall also have an oversight that the singing be and remain pure.

At Keppel (1570) the precentress began Matins. **Nassau-Dillenburg, *Ordnung für das Kloster Keppel*, 1570** (Sehling 10, p. 133):

But at Matins the precentress shall begin in German: *Venite exultemus Domino*; thereafter they shall sing three psalms, and with each psalm read a short summary before or after

Keppel also had a "lecturess or prioress" (*Leßmeisterin*) among its spiritual offices (§16.7.3). Lüneburg (1574) sent home any girl who would not learn enough Latin to "help to sing and read in the choir" (Sehling 6/1, p. 622). The Neuenwalde order (1606/1614) bade the sisters come into the choir before the service on feast days "and help to sing" (Sehling 7/1, p. 41).

No woman cantor in the parish. The parish cantor was a schoolman (§15.9). At Naumburg and Nördlingen even the people's choir "hath its own cantor" (Sehling 2, p. 72; 12, p. 320), a precentor for the congregation whom the orders do not name. No parish order names a woman as cantor or precentor, and at Hof the girls' choir itself was led by men.

16.9.7 Laymen at the Lord's Table

The rule: the ministers give the bread and the cup. In the Lutheran orders the pastor gives the bread, and the cup is given by the deacon, who is an ordained minister (§§16.4.2, 16.5.1). Laymen served around the altar:

- the sexton prepared the altar and carried the vessels to the sick (§16.7.1);
- boys or honest men held the communion cloth (§14.6.3);
- at Thorn (1575) the sexton stood by "to help the old, weak and sick people up and down" at the altar (Sehling 4, p. 237).

But no Lutheran order gives a layman the bread. Hesse argued the rule from the early church, and then allowed exceptions for the cup. **Hesse, *Kirchenordnung*, 1566** (Moderate Reformed; Sehling 8, p. 312):

So also the epistle of the synod of Alexandria in Athanasius, Apology 2, saith expressly: It belongeth to none to reach the blood of Christ but to the ordained presidents of the church alone. […] But where there is no chaplain, the pastor doeth it alone, or, if the number of the communicants be great, with the help of one of the seniors, the schoolmaster or the sexton. And where this case falleth out, that no chaplain or minister appointed to the office of preaching is at hand who could serve in the reaching of the cup when need requireth, there shall always be used for it not a person of a worldly office, but a deacon, senior or keeper of the chest, a schoolmaster (so far as he is a student of theology and not of another faculty), or a sexton. But this distinction shall be kept: that those whom one will use for it be of repute in the doctrine and faith of all the chief articles of the Christian religion, sound especially in the article of the Supper, and of good report and name with the congregation.

The Hessian seniors and deacons were themselves ordained with laying on of hands in 1566 (§§16.5.3, 16.6.2). The schoolmaster and the sexton were not.

Nassau-Weilburg 1617: no more laymen at the cup. The Lutheran county of Nassau-Weilburg ended the practice, together with the communion cloth. **Nassau-Weilburg, *Erläuterungspunkte zur Kirchenordnung*, 1617** (Sehling 10, p. 351):

4. We are informed that in some few places a little cloth is still held before the communicants as they go to the Lord's table; the same shall hereby be abolished […] 5. The pastors and church ministers shall include the communicants in the common prayer from the pulpit. 6. No layman shall henceforth serve the cup any more, but the church ministers themselves.

The Reformed table: passed from hand to hand. In Micron's order for the Dutch church in London (Reformed), the communicants sat at the table. The minister gave the bread and the cup only to those nearest him, and the rest passed them on. **Micron, *Ordinancien* (1554), German edition, 1565** (Reformed; Sehling 7/1, p. 634):

Then the two dishes on both sides are pushed along in order to the end of the table, by him and the other brethren sitting there, that every one may take a piece out of them for himself and eat it in remembrance of the body of Christ, which was given into death for him. […] And then he giveth the two cups to the brethren which sit on both sides

Laymen at the cloth. In Hohenlohe the answers to the questions on church ceremonies of 1596 show the cloth held in every parish. The only difference was who held it: "at Weikersheim it is schoolboys; at Adolzhausen, Hollenbach and Schäftersheim the two churchwardens (*Heiligenpfleger*)" (Sehling 15, p. 534, editors' note).

16.9.8 Laymen leading prayer and reading in church

The Litany. The Litany was the one long prayer of the church that laymen led. Usually two to four boys knelt before the altar and sang the petitions, and the choir and people answered (§10.12.3, §13.21.3). In some orders the schoolmaster or the sexton led it. **Regensburg, *Wahrhaftiger Bericht*, 1542** (Sehling 13, p. 391):

that at the beginning, after the sermon and before the same office, the schoolmaster with his boys and helpers singeth the Litany, that is, the common prayer for all estates and needs of Christendom; so that certain of them begin to sing the first choir, and the other choir answereth thereupon.

Brunswick-Wolfenbüttel, *Christlike kerken-ordeninge*, 1543 (Sehling 6/1, p. 58), on the villages:

In the villages the pastors shall hold it so too, and sing with the peasants as much as is possible for them. They with their sextons shall take pains to teach the peasants to sing with one accord and to praise God. When on the holy day they have no communicants at the Mass after the sermon, the pastor or the sexton shall sing the German Litany after the sermon, and accustom the people thereto, that they can answer finely with one accord in the Litany. Thereupon followeth a German collect for all manner of need, and the last blessing, given to the people by the pastor.

In the Hildesheim order for Steuerwald and Peine the sexton alone sings it. **Steuerwald and Peine, *Kirchenordnung*, 1561** (Sehling 7/2.1, p. 783):

But when there are no communicants, the sexton shall sing the German Litany after the sermon; thereupon followeth a German collect for all manner of need, and lastly the blessing, as above.

So where there was no Supper, the Litany led by a layman took the place of the Communion (§13.21.1). At Aschersleben (1575) "the boys shall begin the Litany" (Sehling 2, p. 480).

The sexton's service in the filial churches. The Saxon General Articles of 1557 gave the sexton a reading service where the pastor could not come, and drew the line at preaching. **Electoral Saxony, *General-Artikel und gemeiner Bericht*, 8 May 1557** (Sehling 1, p. 326):

the sextons, in those places where the parish churches have filials, shall, as often as the pastor preacheth early in one of the same places, meanwhile read to the people in the other places, where they cannot hear the pastor's sermon, the epistle and gospel of the same Sunday, and sing certain Christian German songs. But when the pastor of the same place preacheth in the afternoon, the sexton shall then read the catechism to the youth in the other place, and exercise them diligently therein. But no bell-ringer that is not examined and ordained shall be permitted to preach beyond this. But if they be examined and ordained, and called also to take charge of the office of the diaconate, they shall be granted and permitted not only to preach, but also the other offices of the church, with hearing confession, reaching the sacrament and the like.

The Saxon order of 1580 repeats the rule, but asks only that the bell-ringer be "examined" (Sehling 1, p. 452). In the Weimar superintendency (1570) the sexton "sings Vespers at the other place, and reads the catechism to the people and examines them therein" (Sehling 1, p. 688).

Collects, responses and hymns. The sexton also gave the people's responses, led their singing, and at need closed the office with the collect:

- **Responses.** "The sexton answereth: And with thy spirit" (Pfalz-Zweibrücken 1557, Sehling 18, p. 212; Lüneburg 1564, Sehling 6/1, p. 553; Brunswick-Wolfenbüttel 1569, Sehling 6/1, p. 155).
- **Hymns.** The sexton sings the Lord's Prayer with the people (the villages of Brunswick, Sehling 6/1, p. 473), the communion hymn (Ritschenhausen 1566, Sehling 2, p. 346), and the closing *Sei Lob und Ehr* (Praise and honour be to the highest good; Steuerwald and Peine 1561, Sehling 7/2.1, p. 783).
- **The collect.** At the maidens' convent of Kolberg the sexton read the closing collect when the preacher was absent. **Kolberg, *Statuten für das Jungfrauenkloster*, 1586** (Sehling 4, p. 502):

The preacher of the convent also shall, where he is not hindered, be at the ceremonies, and read a collect at the close; or the sexton, who shall always help to begin the singing of the psalms, [shall] close with the collect, if the pastor be not present.

Daily prayer led by the schoolmaster. The Reformed lordship of Homburg had the schoolmaster hold a daily evening prayer in church. **Homburg (Wittgenstein), *Kirchenzuchtordnung*, 1605** (Reformed; Sehling 22, p. 142):

Further, in every parish church the bell shall be rung every day in the evening at four o'clock; and then the schoolmaster shall go into the church with the scholars, where a psalm shall be sung, and a prayer with the Lord's Prayer said for the need of the Christian church, and a chapter out of the Bible read publicly. And then the people who dwell in the church villages, or at the least one person out of every house, shall go into the church, be present at the prayer and singing, and diligently hear and take to heart what is read out of the Bible.

In the Hohenlohe filial village of Herbsthausen the schoolmaster held the daily prayer, and the pastor complained in 1588 that he sang hymns other than those appointed (Sehling 15, p. 596, editors' note).

Boys as readers. At Naumburg (1537/38) the cantor appointed each Saturday the boys who would serve the coming week as "monitors, readers, catechists, versicle-singers and intoners" (Sehling 2, p. 89). Boys read the epistle at Vespers in Rostock (§16.3.5), and at Hof a chapter of Sirach "within the rails of the altar" (§16.9.6).

Laymen in the "prophecy". The Lutheran orders let no layman preach. Micron's Reformed order for London gave laymen a voice in the weekly "prophecy", the public examination of the week's doctrine, but only chosen men. **Micron, *Ordinancien* (1554), German edition, 1565** (Reformed; Sehling 7/1, pp. 608–609):

it is not permitted to every one to bring forward questions in the prophecy; but there are appointed, out of the elders and deacons and also out of the rest of the congregation, god-fearing and able men, of whom there is testimony that they seek nothing else than the honour of God and the edifying of the congregation; to them alone is it allowed to bring forward anything in the prophecy. […] There is yet another order of the prophecy, which is used in some congregations: namely, that a book of Scripture be expounded in order, not by the minister of the word alone, but also by the elders, deacons and other able men out of the congregation appointed thereto; who, when a place of holy Scripture hath been read, expound it one after another, each according to his gift, teaching, admonishing and comforting the congregation.

Sehling's editors think this second form peculiar to the Dutch church in London (Sehling 7/1, p. 609, note 16).

16.9.9 Who read the prayer bids

The minister. The general prayer and its bids belonged to the minister: the pastor, or the deacon, from the pulpit (§6.1.2). The orders that name the reader name a minister. **Nördlingen, *Ordnung der ceremonien*, 1544, revised 1555** (Sehling 12, p. 318):

3. Thereupon one of the deacons readeth to the people the exhortation to the common prayer, confession and absolution.

Prussia, *Kirchenordnung*, 1568 (Sehling 4, p. 79):

after the *Benedictus* or *Te Deum laudamus* (We praise thee, O God) the whole church singeth *Wir glauben* (We believe), etc.; after which the chaplain readeth off the common prayer, and after the prayer is sung *Nun bitten wir den Heiligen Geist* (Now pray we the Holy Ghost), etc.; therewith the pastor goeth into the pulpit and preacheth the gospel of the day.

Aschersleben, *Kirchen agenda*, 1575 (Sehling 2, p. 480), at the weekday early service:

2. Thereupon followeth the lesson of a chapter of the Old Testament with Veit Dietrich's summaries; the deacon who is of the week doeth it. 3. Thereupon he maketh Master Petrus Plateanus's exhortation to prayer; and if there are sick to be prayed for, that is done also.

The Litany: the bids sung by laymen. The exception was the Litany, "the common prayer for all estates" (Regensburg 1542), whose petitions boys, the schoolmaster or the sexton sang (§16.9.8). Hohenlohe's editors call Luther's German Litany "a special form of the general prayer of intercession", sung where there were scholars to sing it (Sehling 15, p. 611, note 57).

Requests for prayer. Laypeople, women among them, asked for the church's prayer, and the minister named them in the general prayer. **Augsburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1537** (Sehling 12, p. 70):

And in especial have mercy upon certain which at this time desire our intercession in their suffering, sickness and tribulation! Here he shall announce those which desire the common prayer, and thereupon say: Let all that befall them fatherly, faithful God, which according to thy will they desire to obtain of thee through our intercession!

The requests came in by word or on slips laid on the pulpit. Stade allowed slips for the sick only in cases that could not wait, and the first it names is a woman's. **Stade, *Kirchenordnung*, about 1620/22** (Sehling 7/1, p. 55):

4. After the epistle sermons on feast days and Sundays no slips shall be read on the pulpit, nor prayers made, for any sick, unless it be that a woman laboureth in the pangs of childbirth, or one wrestleth with death, or hath died at midday between the sermons, for which God is to be thanked.

The visitation recess for Bardenfleth in Oldenburg (1609) speaks of the common prayer being "profaned and unhallowed with such frivolous things". The editors explain that people laid anonymous slips on the pulpit, asking the pastor to pray about thefts

and losses, insults, and lawsuits against their opponents (Sehling 7/2.1, pp. 1198–1199). Even the council's notices were to be read by the clergy, not by its own servants. **Stendal, *Visitations-Abschied*, 1578** (Sehling 3, p. 331):

It is also thought good by the visitors, for the avoiding of all manner of evil talk and unseemliness, that the honourable council deliver its complaints to the pastors or chaplains on a slip, and have them read off by them, but on the other hand keep the town servants off the pulpit.

So the bids were the minister's from first to last. Women and laymen appear in them as those who asked, or as those prayed for: "women with child" is a standing bid of the general prayer (Chapter 6).

16.10 Table by order

The table summarises, for each order quoted, the offices below or beside the pastorate that it knows. The columns are:

- **Minor, liturgical or religious**: minor orders, liturgical roles, sacristans, and religious and semi-religious persons (§16.7).
- **Deacon**: the form of diaconate.
- **Elder**: the form of eldership.
- **Kept, abolished or forbidden**: what is said to be kept, abolished or forbidden.
- **Women and laymen**: what women, and laymen who were not ministers, might do in the services (§16.9).

Order	Volume	Minor, liturgical or religious	Deacon	Elder	Kept, abolished or forbidden	Women and laymen
Luther, *Formula missae*, 1523	1	Candles and incense free	—	—	Neither forbidden nor required	—
Leisnig, *Ordnung eines gemeinen Kastens*, 1523	1	Brotherhoods of the Kaland, St Anne, shoemakers	—	—	Dissolved into the common chest	—
Nürnberg, *Gottesdienstordnung*, 1524	11	Ministrant	—	—	Kept	—
Hadeln, *Kirchenordnung*, 1526	5	—	Lay *leviten* (levites) of the poor	—	Created	—
Homberg, 1526 (Moderate Reformed)	8	Deacon's and subdeacon's vestments	Deacon of the poor only	Bishop = presbyter	Mass-deacons and subdeacons rejected as unscriptural	Women may attend the assembly but not speak; "the men alone shall decide"
Naumburg, St Wenzel, 1527	2	—	—	—	—	Men, maidens and women sing the Creed in German
Brunswick (Bugenhagen), 1528	6/1	No tonsure or deacon's coat	Lay deacons of the chest and the poor	Bishops = preachers	Created; no ministry of word	—

Order	Volume	Minor, liturgical or religious	Deacon	Elder	Kept, abolished or forbidden	Women and laymen
Nürnberg, report for Goslar, 1528	7/2.2	Levites read the lesson and exhort	—	—	Kept	—
Hamburg, 1529	5	Sexton hired by deacons	Sixteen lay deacons of the poor, plus treasury deacons	—	Created	Midwives "may well be called church servants"
Zwickau, visitors, 1529	1	—	—	—	—	Maidens' choir abolished
Heilbronn, 1530	17/1	—	Two *Diaconi* (deacons; assistant preachers) distribute	—	Kept	—
Heilbronn, beguine houses, 1531	17/1	Beguines to visit the sick; no distinct clothing	—	—	Kept as one house	—
Strasbourg, *Ordnung der Kirchenpfleger*, 1531 (Moderate Reformed)	20/1	*Sigristen* appointed by pastors and churchwardens	—	—	Kept	—
Memmingen, *Zuchtordnung*, 1532 (Moderate Reformed)	12	—	—	*Kirchenpfleger* (churchwardens), no temporal jurisdiction	Limited	—
Herford, *Kirchenordnung*, 1532	21	Brothers' and sisters' houses of the Common Life	—	—	Separate communion rejected	—
Nimbschen and Remse, 1533	1	Nuns	—	—	—	Only the appointed preacher preaches and hears confession
Württemberg, *Klosterordnung*, 1535	16	Monks, nuns, novices, beguines, Lollards	—	—	Admissions forbidden; novices sent home	—
Esslingen, Franciscan convent, 1535 (Moderate Reformed)	17/2	Friars	—	—	Free to marry; those staying maintained	—

Order	Volume	Minor, liturgical or religious	Deacon	Elder	Kept, abolished or forbidden	Women and laymen
Freiberg, Visitation articles, 1537	1	Cross, tonsure	—	—	Abolished as human ordinances	—
Naumburg, St Wenzel, 1537	2	—	Twelve lay *subdiaconi oder Bittherren* (subdeacons or bidding-men)	—	Created	Maidens sing as a fourth choir; boys appointed weekly as readers
Augsburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1537	12	—	—	—	—	The minister names those who ask for the common prayer
Lippe, 1538	21	Incense abolished; vestments and lights free	Lay *diaconi* (deacons) of the poor	—	Created	—
Pyritz, 1539	4	—	Four lay *diaconi*, no oath	—	Created	—
Strasbourg, *Examensordnung*, 1539 (Moderate Reformed)	20/1	History of minor orders; exorcism a gift	Deacon apostolic; schoolmasters in the deacons' place	Two orders of presbyters	Minor orders treated as later additions	—
Ziegenhain, *Zuchtordnung*, 1539 (Moderate Reformed)	8	—	—	Lay elders, confirmed with prayer	Created	—
Pfalz-Zweibrücken, 1539	18	—	—	Pastors = bishops = elders	—	—
Brandenburg, 1540	3	Ministrants in dalmatics; lights; cross and lights at funerals	—	—	Kept where clergy suffice	—
Stendal, *Verordnung*, 1540	3	—	—	—	—	Girls' school kept by a woman or the convent maidens
Salzwedel, convent of St Anne, 1540	3	Nuns	—	—	—	Chaplain preaches, hears confession and

Order	Volume	Minor, liturgical or religious	Deacon	Elder	Kept, abolished or forbidden	Women and laymen
						gives the sacrament
Stendal, 1541	3	Cross before procession	—	—	Kept	—
Regensburg, *Wahrhaftiger Bericht*, 1542	13	Two levites (gospeller, epistoler)	—	—	Kept	Schoolmaster and boys sing the Litany
Goslar, convent of Frankenberg, 1542	7/2.2	Nuns	—	—	No admission to the habit; free to marry	—
Pfalz-Neuburg, 1543	13	Ministrants; deacon and subdeacon read, deacon gives cup	—	—	Kept "where there are ministrants"	Convent women read their lessons, chapters and collects in German
Heilbronn, *Kirchenordnung*, 1543	17/1	Sexton, not women, at the font	—	—	Kept	Women and maids barred from the font and the towel
Regensburg, *Kirchenordnung des Noppus*, 1543	13	*Seelfrauen* (soul-women) and men for the sick and dying	—	—	Kept under the word	—
Brunswick-Wolfenbüttel, *Christlike kerken-ordeninge*, 1543	6/1	—	—	—	—	Pastor or sexton sings the Litany in the villages
Soest, convent of St Walburgis, 1543	22	Nuns; schoolmistress chosen from the sisters	—	—	—	*Cantrix* directs the choir; young sisters read at table
Transylvania, Honterus, *Reformationsbüchlein*, 1543	24	—	—	—	—	Schoolgirls sing and put the catechism questions in church
Nördlingen, *Kirchenordnung Kaspar Löners*, 1544	12	Sick-women examined by the pastor	—	—	Kept	—

Order	Volume	Minor, liturgical or religious	Deacon	Elder	Kept, abolished or forbidden	Women and laymen
Wittenbergische Reformation, 1545	1	—	—	Bishops a grade above priests by human foresight	—	—
Nürnberg, *Agendbüchlein* of Veit Dietrich, 1545	11	Sexton not to keep the leftover hosts and wine	—	—	—	Paul's ban on women preaching as a model church ordinance
Strasbourg, Marbach, 1553	20/1	—	—	*Kirchenpfleger* = *seniores*	Created	—
Regensburg, Jonas, 1553	13	Rota of ordained ministers as ministrants or deacons	—	—	Kept	—
Hohenlohe, *Kirchenordnung*, 1553	15	Sexton carries chalice, corporal, surplice to the sick	—	—	Kept	Paul's ban on women preaching as a model church ordinance
Regensburg, 29 April 1554	13	Levites and Mass vestments	—	—	Abolished	—
Micron, *Ordinancien*, 1554/65 (Reformed)	7/1	—	Deacons of the poor, hands	Ruling elders, hands; one presiding superintendent	Created	Chosen laymen speak in the "prophecy"; bread and cups passed along the table
Strasbourg, mandate on the women's convents, 1555	20/1	Nuns; prioress and council-mothers	—	—	Admission by the council	—
Nördlingen, *Ordnung der ceremonien*, 1544/1555	12	—	—	—	—	Girls' choir planned; a deacon reads the exhortation to prayer
Schmalkalden, visitors, 1555	2	—	—	—	—	Matron or old man keeps the girls' school; the girls help to sing the Litany
Waldeck, *Kirchenordnung*, 1556	9	Sexton carries the cross	—	—	Kept	—

Order	Volume	Minor, liturgical or religious	Deacon	Elder	Kept, abolished or forbidden	Women and laymen
		before the coffin				
Herrenalb, *Statuten*, 1556	16	Evangelical conventuals and novices	—	—	Kept as a school	—
Württemberg, *Ordnung für Frauenklöster*, 1556	16	Nuns	—	—	—	No schools for the church in the women's convents (1 Cor. 14); a sister reads the chapter
Electoral Saxony, *General-Artikel*, 1557	1	—	—	—	—	Sexton reads the epistle, gospel and catechism in filials; may not preach unless examined and ordained
Rothenburg, *Instruction*, 1558	11	—	—	Elders "god-fearing, wise and valiant men"	—	—
Erbach, *Erbacher Kirchenordnung*, 1560	9	—	—	"Elders" = pastors	—	—
Württemberg, 1559	16	—	*Diacon* (deacon), *Subdiacon* (ministers)	—	Kept as benefices	—
Rostock, *Conformitas*, 1560–76	5	Boys read the epistle	—	—	—	—
Ravengiersburg, *Klosterordnung*, 1560	19/2	Novices trained for the ministry	—	—	Kept as a school; Latin chant allowed	—
Steuerwald and Peine, 1561	7/2.1	—	—	—	—	Sexton sings the Litany and the closing hymn
Brandenburg-Ansbach, *Kapitelsordnung*, 1565/78	11	Levites	—	Two clerical *seniores*	Levites forbidden	—
Hesse, *Kirchenordnung*, 1566 (Moderate Reformed)	8	Sexton as *ianitor*	Deacons of the poor, ordained with hands	Ruling elders, ordained with hands; elders lay	Created	Women barred from "all the actions of the

Order	Volume	Minor, liturgical or religious	Deacon	Elder	Kept, abolished or forbidden	Women and laymen
		(doorkeeper), *aedituus*		hands on ministers		church's service"; seniors, chest-keepers, schoolmasters or sextons may help with the cup
Regensburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1567(?)	13	Levites, vestments, lights	—	—	Abolished	Boys' and girls' schools sing the catechism; two boys question and answer
Prussia, *Kirchenordnung*, 1568	4	—	—	—	—	Chaplain reads the common prayer
Brunswick-Wolfenbüttel, *Klosterordnung*, 1569	6/1	Nuns' cowl, veil and crown	—	—	Habit to be laid aside	—
Brunswick-Wolfenbüttel, *Kirchenordnung*, 1569	6/1	Sexton gives the responses	—	—	—	A sister leads the prayer and reads the chapter
Pomerania, *Kerckenordeninge*, 1569	4	—	Deacons of the chest "god-fearing, understanding, upright men"	—	—	—
Keppel, *Ordnung für das Kloster*, 1570	10	Nuns clothed with oath; *domina*; *diaconissa* (deaconess), *custorin*	—	—	Kept, reformed	Precentress begins Matins; lecturess, sacristaness, almoner and church-mistress
Weimar, *Generalia*, 1570	1	—	—	—	—	Sexton sings Vespers and reads the catechism in filials
Lippe, *Kirchenordnung*, 1571	21	Sexton fills the font	—	—	—	Wardens of the fabric "god-fearing, honourable men"
Mecklenburg, *Klosterordnung*, 1572	5	Nuns' habit and	—	—	Consecrated habit	The *domina* and each sister by

Order	Volume	Minor, liturgical or religious	Deacon	Elder	Kept, abolished or forbidden	Women and laymen
		consecration books			abolished	the week lead the prayers and read the lessons
Halle, 1573(?)	2	—	Pastor and two *diaconi*; *unterdiaconi*	—	Kept	—
Pfalz-Veldenz, 1574	18	—	(Acts 6)	Censors, prayer	Created	Censors "honourable men"; women barred from all the lessons (*Lectiones*)
Pomerania, *Statuta synodica*, 1574	4	Lay *diaconi* keep the altar and its ornament	*Diaconi ecclesiae et pauperum* (Deacons of the church and of the poor), oath	Clerical *seniores*	Created	—
Lüneburg, *Klosterordnung*, 1574	6/1	Nuns' clothing under the duke; cowl, veil and crown	—	—	Plain habit	Girls learn Latin "to help to sing and read in the choir"
Hesse, *Agende*, 1574 (Philippist)	8	—	—	—	—	Women barred from all the "actions" of the church's service; midwives not to baptize
Dresden, *Gottesdienst-Ordnung der Kreuzkirche*, 1574	1	—	—	—	—	Girls and maidservants sing the German hymn
Aschersleben, *Kirchen agenda*, 1575	2	—	—	—	—	Deacon of the week exhorts to prayer; boys begin the Litany; girls catechized
Thorn, *Kirchenordnung*, 1575	4	Sexton helps the old and sick at the altar	—	—	—	—
Bohemian Brethren, *Ordo ecclesiasticus*, 1576	4	Acolytes (ordained grade)	Clerical deacons, hands	Lay presbyters and *presbyterae*, handfast	Kept; deacon "not to be cast out"	Women elders (*presbyterae*); matrons help

Order	Volume	Minor, liturgical or religious	Deacon	Elder	Kept, abolished or forbidden	Women and laymen
						examine the girls
Nassau-Weilburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1576	10	—	—	—	—	Women silent in the congregation (the Hessian text)
Electoral Saxony, *Visitations-Instruktion*, 1577	1	—	—	—	—	Schoolmistress visited with the schoolmasters and sextons
Stendal, *Visitations-Abschied*, 1578	3	—	—	—	—	Council's notices read by the clergy; town servants kept off the pulpit
Münster im Gregoriental, 1578	20/2	—	—	—	—	Schoolmasters lead the singing so that men and women can join
Cottbus, 1579	3	—	—	—	—	Widow made schoolmistress for life
Electoral Saxony, 1580	1	Bell-ringers' sale of font water and hosts forbidden	*Diaconat*, *Subdiaconat*; same ordination as pastor	—	Diaconate may be dispensed	Sexton reads the catechism; may not preach unless examined
Moers, 1581 (Reformed)	22	—	*Diaconi oder Almusenpfleger* (deacons or almoners)	—	Created	—
Hoya, *Kirchenordnung*, 1581	6/2	Sexton keeps the clock himself	—	—	—	Women told to sing aloud in church
Nassau-Dillenburg, 1582 (Reformed)	10	*Aeditui* elected by presbytery	Deacons of the poor	Seniors; four offices	Created	—
Frankfurt, Dutch congregation (Augsburg Confession), 1585 (Lutheran)	9	—	Two *diaconi*	—	Created	—
Lauenburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1585	5	Sextons may keep girls'	—	—	—	Sextons' wives teach

Order	Volume	Minor, liturgical or religious	Deacon	Elder	Kept, abolished or forbidden	Women and laymen
		schools				needlework; matrons as schoolmistresses
Kolberg, maidens' convent, 1586	4	—	—	—	—	Sexton reads the collect in the preacher's absence
Transylvania, *Landesordnung*, 1587	24	—	—	Two "upright men" as church-fathers	—	—
Bentheim-Tecklenburg, 1588/1619 (Reformed)	22	Baptismal exorcism	*Diaconi oder Almusenpfleger*	Seniors	Exorcism abolished	—
Sayn, *Kirchenordnung*, 1590	19/1	Bell-ringer keeps chalices and ornaments	—	—	Kept	—
Augsburg, *Vergleichsartikel*, 1591	12	—	—	Six *Kirchenpfleger*	—	—
Hof, *Ordo ecclesiasticus*, 1592	11	Subdeacon reads epistle	*Subdiaconus* (minister)	—	Kept	Girls' choir, led by the superintendent or the deacon; a boy reads Sirach at the altar
Kurpfalz, *Einführung der Senioren*, 1592 (Reformed)	19/2	—	—	Ruling elders, hands	Created	—
Anhalt, sexton of Törten, 1594 (Philippist)	2	Sexton prepares altar and font, vests the pastor	—	—	Kept	—
Emden, *Summarische beschryvinge*, 1594 (Reformed)	7/1	—	—	—	—	Four widows and matrons chosen for the hospital
Hohenlohe, questions on church ceremonies, 1596	15	—	—	—	—	Schoolboys or churchwardens hold the communion cloth
Kurpfalz, *Presbyterordnung*,	14	—	—	Yearly elders, handfast vow	Created	—

Order	Volume	Minor, liturgical or religious	Deacon	Elder	Kept, abolished or forbidden	Women and laymen
about 1601 (Reformed)				and prayer; Matthew 18		
Fischbeck, 1602 (editors' note)	7/2.2	Sacristaness (*Küsterin*)	—	—	—	—
Solms-Laubach, 1603	9	—	—	Elders, oath	Created	—
Wild- and Rhinegraviate, 1603	19/2	—	—	Censors, oath	Created	Censors "honourable men"
Obernkirchen, 1603	7/2.2	Nuns	—	—	—	The sisters administer their own service: read, sing and pray
Bruchhausen (Corvey), 1603	21	—	—	—	—	Women silent in the congregation (the Hessian text)
Homburg (Wittgenstein), 1605 (Reformed)	22	—	—	—	—	Schoolmaster holds the daily prayer
Hanau-Münzenberg, 1609 (Reformed)	10	—	—	Elders, handfast vow and prayer; "of God"	Created	—
Bardenfleth (Oldenburg), 1609	7/2.1	—	—	—	—	Slips asking for prayer misused
Schwäbisch Hall, 1543/1615	17/1	Cross before coffin, "significatively"	—	—	Allowed	—
Schleswig-Holstein, *Klosterordnung für Frauenklöster*, after 1610	23	Abbess and prioress elected under oath	—	—	Kept	—
Neuenwalde, *Klosterordnung*, 1606/1614	7/1	Nuns	—	—	—	The sisters help to sing in the choir on feast days
Nassau-Weilburg, 1617	10	—	—	—	—	Communion cloth abolished; no layman to serve the cup
Stade, *Kirchenordnung*,	7/1	—	—	—	—	Slips for the sick only in urgent

Order	Volume	Minor, liturgical or religious	Deacon	Elder	Kept, abolished or forbidden	Women and laymen
about 1620/22						cases, such as a woman in labour

16.11 Concordance of the orders quoted

Every order quoted or cited in this chapter is listed below by region. The table gives:

- **Sehling**: the volume and pages in Sehling's edition.
- **Doc**: the `eko.db` document that holds the text, for full-text lookup. A single database record may hold several orders.
- **§**: the sections where the order is quoted or cited.

Passages from Sehling's own introductions are marked "editors' introduction".

Saxony, Thuringia and central Germany

Order	Sehling	Doc	§
Luther, *Formula missae et communionis pro ecclesia Wittembergensi*, 1523	1, p. 5	2	16.4.4
Freiberg, *Visitationsartikel* of Dr Jacob Schenk, 1537	1, p. 466	48	16.3.3
Freiberg, *Artikel*, 1538	1, p. 468	49	16.4.5
Ernestine Saxony, *Wittenbergische Reformation*, 1545	1, pp. 217–218	20	16.5.4
Electoral Saxony, *Kirchenordnung* of Elector August, 1580	1, pp. 375, 381–383, 426, 452	44	16.3.3, 16.5.1, 16.5.4, 16.7.1, 16.9.8
Naumburg, *Kirchen-Ordnung für die St. Wenzelskirche*, 1537	2, pp. 64, 72, 89	1219	16.5.2, 16.9.6, 16.9.8
Halle, *Kirchen-Ordnung der christlichen Gemein zu Hall in Sachsen*, 1573(?)	2, pp. 441–442	1257	16.3.3, 16.5.1
Leisnig, *Ordnung eines gemeinen Kastens*, 1523	1, p. 599	102	16.7.2, 16.7.6
Schönburg, *Kirchen-Ordnung* of Johann Pfeffinger, 18 October 1542	2, p. 176	1235	16.7.1
Anhalt, *Ordnung der deutschen Gesänge*, before 1551	2, p. 555	1262	16.4.5
Anhalt, *Ordnung für den Küster zu Törten*, 8 November 1594 (Philippist)	2, pp. 579–580	1262	16.7.1
Naumburg, *Kirchen-Ordnung für die St. Wenzelskirche*, 1527	2, pp. 59–60	1218	16.9.6
Zwickau, *Verordnung der Visitatoren*, 1529	1, p. 722	151	16.9.6
Nimbschen, *Verordnung der Visitatoren für das Kloster*, 1533	1, p. 619	111	16.9.3
Remse, *Ordnung in das Jungfrauenkloster*, 1533	1, p. 652	125	16.9.3
Electoral Saxony, *General-Artikel und gemeiner Bericht*, 8 May 1557	1, p. 326	37	16.9.8
Weimar, *Generalia für die Pfarreien der Superintendenz*, 1570	1, p. 688	143	16.9.8

Order	Sehling	Doc	§
Dresden, *Gottesdienst-Ordnung der Kreuzkirche*, 1574	1, p. 555	78	16.9.6
Electoral Saxony, *Visitations-Instruktion*, 1577	1, p. 350	40	16.9.4
Schmalkalden, *Ordnung der Visitatoren*, 1555	2, p. 348	1249	16.9.4
Ritschenhausen, *Gottesdienst-Ordnung*, 1566	2, p. 346	1249	16.9.8
Aschersleben, *Kirchen agenda*, 1575	2, p. 480	1260	16.9.6, 16.9.8, 16.9.9

Brandenburg, Pomerania and the North Sea and Baltic cities

Order	Sehling	Doc	§
Brandenburg, *Kirchenordnung* of Joachim II, 1540	3, pp. 71, 81	1746	16.4.1, 16.4.4, 16.4.5
Stendal, ordinance of the visitors of the Mark Brandenburg, 1541	3, p. 314	1785	16.4.5
Prenzlau, *Abschied*, 1557	3, p. 261	1776	16.4.5
Pyritz, *Abschied*, 1539	4, p. 519	1879	16.5.2
Pomerania, *Statuta synodica*, 1574	4, pp. 489, 491	1868	16.5.2, 16.6.5, 16.7.2
Rostock, *Conformitas ceremoniarum in singulis templis ecclesiae Rostochiensis*, 1560–1576	5, p. 289	1936	16.3.5
Hamburg, *Hamburger Kirchenordnung*, 1529	5, pp. 512–514, 535	1960	16.3.3, 16.3.5, 16.5.2, 16.9.4
Lübeck, *Kirchenordnung*, 1531	5, p. 359	1949	16.1, 16.5.2
Hadeln, *Hadelner Kirchenordnung*, 1526	5, p. 472	1955	16.5.2
Mecklenburg, *Klosterordnung*, 1572	5, pp. 254–255, 257, 260	1926	16.7.5, 16.9.4, 16.9.5
Schleswig-Holstein, *Klosterordnung für Frauenklöster*, after 1610	23, p. 182	1584	16.7.5
Stendal, *Verordnung und Bestellung aller Pfarrkirchen*, 1540	3, p. 310	1784	16.9.4
Salzwedel, *Abschied für das Kloster St. Annen*, 1540	3, p. 272	1779	16.9.3
Stendal, *Visitations-Abschied*, 11 August 1578	3, p. 331	1787	16.9.9
Cottbus, *Visitations-Abschied*, 1579	3, p. 201	1761	16.9.4
Pomerania, *Kerckenordeninge*, 1569	4, p. 409	1862	16.9.3
Kolberg, *Statuten für das Jungfrauenkloster*, 1586	4, p. 502	1873	16.9.5, 16.9.8
Prussia, *Kirchenordnung*, 1568	4, p. 79	1833	16.9.9
Thorn, *Kirchenordnung*, 1575	4, p. 237	1844	16.9.7
Lauenburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1585	5, pp. 422, 446	1953	16.9.4

Lower Saxony, East Frisia and Westphalia

Order	Sehling	Doc	§
Brunswick, *Kirchenordnung* of Johannes Bugenhagen, 1528	6/1, p. 449	1983	16.3.3, 16.5.2, 16.5.4
Hildesheim, editors' introduction on Bugenhagen's order of 1544	7/2.1, p. 811	2132	16.1, 16.5.2, 16.5.4

Order	Sehling	Doc	§
East Frisia, editors' introduction to Micron's *Ordinancien* (Reformed)	7/1, pp. 554–555	2115	16.5.3
Micron, *Ordinancien* (1554) 1565 (Reformed)	7/1, pp. 583, 587–588, 596–598, 608–609, 634	2116	16.5.3, 16.6.3, 16.9.3, 16.9.7, 16.9.8
Lippe, *Lippische Kirchenordnung*, 1538	21, pp. 318, 335	1459	16.4.4, 16.5.2, 16.8
Moers, *Kirchenordnung*, 1581 (Reformed)	22, p. 201	1502	16.5.3
Bentheim-Tecklenburg, *Bentheim-Tecklenburger Kirchenordnung*, 1588/1619 (Reformed)	22, pp. 269, 276	1508	16.3.5, 16.5.3
Brunswick-Wolfenbüttel, *Klosterordnung*, 1569	6/1, pp. 324–326	1978	16.7.5
Lüneburg, *Klosterordnung* of Duke William the Younger, 1574	6/1, p. 622	2010	16.7.5, 16.9.6
Goslar, *Ordnung für das Frauenkloster Frankenberg*, 1542	7/2.2, p. 275	2198	16.7.5
Lemgo, *Lemgoer Kirchenordnung*, 1537	21, p. 302	1458	16.7.6
Lippe, *Kirchenordnung*, 1571	21, pp. 447, 449	1462	16.7.1, 16.9.3
Herford, *Kirchenordnung*, 1532	21, pp. 173–174	1442	16.7.6
Herford, editors' introduction	21, p. 160	1441	16.7.6
Brunswick-Wolfenbüttel, *Christlike kerken-ordeninge*, 1543	6/1, p. 58	1972	16.9.8
Brunswick-Wolfenbüttel, *Kirchenordnung*, 1569	6/1, pp. 155, 260	1974	16.9.5, 16.9.8
Brunswick, *Ordnung der ceremonien auf den dorfern*, n.d.	6/1, p. 473	1988	16.9.8
Lüneburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1564	6/1, p. 553	2003	16.9.8
Hoya, *Kirchenordnung*, 1581	6/2, pp. 1142, 1192	2065	16.9.4, 16.9.6
Steuerwald and Peine, *Kirchenordnunge in baiden gerichten*, 1561	7/2.1, p. 783	2129	16.9.8
Oldenburg, *Visitationsabschied für Bardenfleth*, 1609, with editors' note	7/2.1, pp. 1198–1199	2151	16.9.9
Stade, *Kirchenordnung*, about 1620/22	7/1, p. 55	2079	16.9.9
Bremen, *Neuenwalder Klosterordnung*, 1606/1614	7/1, p. 41	2076	16.9.6
Schaumburg, *Vereinbarung für das Stift Fischbeck*, 1602, editors' note	7/2.2, p. 81	2172	16.9.4
Schaumburg, *Ordnung für das Stift Obernkirchen*, 1603	7/2.2, p. 88	2174	16.9.5
Emden, *Summarische beschryvinge der ordnung in der christlicken kercken to Embden*, 1594 (Reformed)	7/1, p. 505	2113	16.9.3
Corvey, *Kirchenordnung für das Stiftsdorf Bruchhausen*, 1603	21, p. 253	1455	16.9.2
Soest, *Ordnung für das Kloster St. Walburgis*, 1543	22, p. 468	1530	16.9.4, 16.9.5, 16.9.6
Homburg (Wittgenstein), *Kirchenzuchtordnung*, 1605 (Reformed)	22, p. 142	1493	16.9.8

Hesse, the Wetterau and the Middle Rhine

Order	Sehling	Doc	§
Hesse, *Homberger Kirchenordnung*, 1526 (Moderate Reformed)	8, p. 46	2247	16.3.2
Hesse, *Ziegenhainer Zuchtordnung*, 1539 (Moderate Reformed)	8, p. 103	2252	16.6.2
Hesse, *Kirchenordnung*, 1566 (Moderate Reformed)	8, pp. 180, 195, 205, 207–211, 282–283, 312	2257	16.3.5, 16.5.3, 16.6.2, 16.9.2, 16.9.7
Solms, *Kirchenzuchtordnung*, 1594 (Reformed)	9, p. 338	2311	16.6.3
Erbach, *Erbacher Kirchenordnung*, 1560	9, p. 446	2316	16.6.5
Frankfurt, *Stiftungsbrief des Armenkastens der Niederländischen Gemeinde A. C.*, 1585 (Lutheran)	9, p. 604	2332	16.5.2
Nassau-Dillenburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 23 January 1582 (Reformed)	10, p. 160	184	16.5.3, 16.6.3
Ysenburg-Ronneburg, *Memorial zur Kirchenzuchtordnung*, 1592 (Reformed)	10, p. 601	223	16.6.3
Hanau-Münzenberg, *Presbyteriumsordnung*, 1609 (Reformed)	10, p. 508	211	16.6.3
Wild- and Rhinegraviate, *Kirchenordnung*, 1603	19/2, p. 600	1121	16.6.3, 16.9.3
Waldeck, *Kirchenordnung*, 1556	9, p. 256	2300	16.4.5
Nassau-Dillenburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1537	10, p. 84	169	16.7.6
Nassau-Dillenburg, *Ordnung für das Kloster Keppel*, 1570	10, pp. 133, 141–142	181	16.7.3, 16.7.5, 16.9.3, 16.9.6
Sayn, *Kirchenordnung*, 1590	19/1, p. 438	1090	16.7.1
Hesse, *Homberger Kirchenordnung*, 1526 (Moderate Reformed), the assembly of the faithful	8, p. 52	2249	16.9.2, 16.9.3
Hesse, *Agende*, 1574 (Philippist)	8, pp. 428–429	2272	16.9.2
Nassau-Weilburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1576	10, p. 249	198	16.9.2
Nassau-Weilburg, *Erläuterungspunkte zur Kirchenordnung*, 1617	10, p. 351	199	16.9.7

The Palatinates

Order	Sehling	Doc	§
Pfalz-Neuburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1543	13, pp. 70–71, 75, 78	386	16.4.2, 16.9.5
Kurpfalz, editors' introduction on the discipline dispute, 1568–1570 (Reformed)	14, p. 53	468	16.1, 16.6.3
Kurpfalz, *Presbyterordnung*, about 1601 (Reformed)	14, pp. 595, 598	518	16.6.3
Kurpfalz, *Einführung der Senioren*, 9 December 1592 (Reformed)	19/2, pp. 789–790	1155	16.6.3
Kurpfalz, editors' introduction to the *Einführung der Senioren* (Reformed)	19/2, p. 695	1133	16.6.3
Pfalz-Zweibrücken, *Kirchenordnung „Form und Ordnung“*, 1539	18, p. 63	965	16.5.4

Order	Sehling	Doc	§
Pfalz-Veldenz, *Kirchenordnung*, 1574	18, pp. 473, 572–573	1011	16.6.3, 16.9.2, 16.9.3
Pfalz-Neuburg, *Generalartikel*, 1576	13, p. 208	404	16.7.2
Pfalz-Simmern, *Klosterordnung Ravengiersburg*, 1560	19/2, p. 658	1125	16.7.4
Heidelberg, *Spitalordnung*, 1594 (Reformed)	19/2, p. 827	1163	16.7.3
Pfalz-Zweibrücken, *Kirchenordnung*, 1557	18, p. 212	967	16.9.8

Franconia, Bavaria, Swabia and Alsace

Order	Sehling	Doc	§
Nürnberg, *Gottesdienstordnung der Pfarrkirchen*, 1524	11, p. 52	249	16.4.1
Nürnberg, *Bericht der Stadt Nürnberg für den Goslarer Rat*, 30 March 1528	7/2.2, p. 230	2186	16.3.5, 16.4.3
Brandenburg-Ansbach-Kulmbach, *Kapitelsordnung*, 1565/78	11, pp. 347, 350, 357	283	16.4.3, 16.6.5
Hof, *Ordo ecclesiasticus*, 1592	11, pp. 425, 428, 463, 474	294	16.3.5, 16.9.6, 16.9.8
Augsburg, *Vergleichsartikel*, 1591	12, pp. 109–110	341	16.6.5
Dinkelsbühl, *Kirchenpflegeordnung*, 1574	12, p. 131	348	16.6.5
Memmingen, *Zuchtordnung*, 1532 (Moderate Reformed)	12, p. 248	365	16.6.5
Regensburg, *Wahrhaftiger Bericht*, 1542	13, pp. 391, 393	432	16.4.3, 16.9.8
Regensburg, *Kirchenordnung unter Justus Jonas*, 1553	13, pp. 419–421	440	16.4.2
Regensburg, *Warum die leviten- und meßgewand sollen abgetan werden*, 29 April 1554	13, p. 432	443	16.4.3
Regensburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1567(?)	13, pp. 464, 480	450	16.4.3, 16.4.4, 16.9.5
Württemberg, *Ordnung der Besetzung von Kirchendienerstellen*, 1559	16, p. 348	683	16.3.3
Heilbronn, *„Confessio Heilbronnensis“ und Kirchenordnung*, 1530	17/1, p. 285	770	16.4.2
Schwäbisch Hall, *Kirchenordnung* 1543/1615	17/1, p. 173	763	16.4.5
Strasbourg, *Examensordnung*, Latin version, 1539 (Moderate Reformed)	20/1, pp. 304, 310	1308	16.3.1, 16.6.1
Strasbourg, *Kirchenordnung* of Johannes Marbach, 1553	20/1, p. 441	1321	16.6.1
Nürnberg, *Agendbüchlein* of Veit Dietrich, 1545	11, pp. 531, 549	297	16.7.1, 16.9.2
Brandenburg-Ansbach-Kulmbach, *Kirchenvisitation*, 1536	11, p. 320	277	16.7.3
Brandenburg-Ansbach-Kulmbach, *Konsistorialordnung*, 1594	11, p. 391	291	16.7.1
Nördlingen, *Kirchenordnung Kaspar Löners*, 1544	12, p. 315	372	16.7.3
Regensburg, *Kirchenordnung des Noppus*, 1543	13, p. 410	436	16.7.3
Wolfstein, *Christliche Instructio* of Thomas Stieber, 1574	13, p. 582	463	16.7.3
Hohenlohe, *Kirchenordnung*, 1553	15, pp. 57, 73	539	16.7.1, 16.9.2
Württemberg, editors' introduction	16, p. 50	644	16.7.6
Württemberg, *Klosterordnung*, 1535	16, pp. 79–80	647	16.7.4, 16.7.6

Order	Sehling	Doc	§
Württemberg, *Mandat gegen Aufnahme von Novizen in den Klöstern*, 1552	16, p. 199	669	16.7.4
Herrenalb, *Statuten für das Zisterzienserkloster*, 1556	16, p. 317	678	16.7.4
Württemberg, *Ordnung der deutschen Schulen*, 1559	17/1, p. 585	813	16.7.1
Baden, *Kirchenordnung*, 1533	16, p. 510	702	16.4.4
Baden, *Kirchenordnungsmandat*, 1601	16, p. 551	713	16.7.1
Heilbronn, *Instruktion zur Zusammenlegung beider Beginenhäuser*, 1531	17/1, p. 298	776	16.7.3, 16.7.6
Heilbronn, *Kirchenordnung*, 1543	17/1, p. 315	781	16.7.1, 16.7.2, 16.9.4
Reutlingen, editors' introduction	17/2, p. 28	825	16.7.6
Esslingen, *Ordnung für die Konventualen im Barfüßerkloster*, 1535 (Moderate Reformed)	17/2, p. 382	882	16.7.4
Strasbourg, *Ordnung der Kirchenpfleger*, 1531 (Moderate Reformed)	20/1, p. 226	1292	16.7.1
Strasbourg, *Mandat zu den noch bestehenden Frauenklöstern*, 1555	20/1, pp. 454, 456	1323	16.7.5
Rothenburg, *Instruction, wie die Kirchenordnung gehandhabt und vollzogen werden soll*, 1558	11, p. 610	302	16.9.3
Schweinfurt, editors' introduction	11, p. 622	303	16.9.6
Augsburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1537	12, p. 70	338	16.9.9
Nördlingen, *Ordnung der ceremonien* of Caspar Löner, 1544, revised 1555	12, pp. 318, 320	373	16.9.6, 16.9.9
Hohenlohe, editors' note on the daily prayer at Herbsthausen, 1588	15, p. 596	614	16.9.8
Hohenlohe, *Fragen über die Kirchenzeremonie*, 1596, editors' note	15, p. 534	602	16.9.7
Hohenlohe, *Visitationsordnung*, 1589, editors' note	15, p. 611	618	16.9.9
Württemberg, *Ordnung für Frauenklöster*, 3 February 1556	16, pp. 304, 307	677	16.9.2, 16.9.5
Münster im Gregoriental, *Ordnung für die Schulmeister*, 1578	20/2, p. 394	1402	16.9.6

Poland

Order	Sehling	Doc	§
Bohemian Brethren, *Ordo ecclesiasticus in unitate fratrum Bohemorum*, 1576 (Hussite)	4, pp. 275–276, 279, 282, 289	1846	16.3.4, 16.5.3, 16.6.4, 16.7.3, 16.9.3

Transylvania

Order	Sehling	Doc	§
Transylvania, Honterus, *Reformationsbüchlein*, 1543	24, pp. 184, 196	1666	16.9.5
Transylvania, *Gemeinsame Landesordnung*, 8 July 1587	24, p. 463	1713	16.9.3

Chapter 17. Confessional Subscription

This chapter covers how the evangelical church orders of the sixteenth and early seventeenth centuries bound people to the confessions, as printed in Emil Sehling's *Die evangelischen Kirchenordnungen des XVI. Jahrhunderts* (The Evangelical Church Orders of the Sixteenth Century). It asks five questions:

- Which documents did each order name as its rule of doctrine, its *corpus doctrinae* (body of doctrine) or *norma doctrinae*? Was it Scripture alone, the Augsburg Confession, the Apology, the Smalcald Articles, Luther's catechisms, Melanchthon's *Loci* (Commonplaces) and *Corpus doctrinae* (body of doctrine), a territorial corpus, the Formula of Concord or the Book of Concord, or a local confession?
- How was a minister bound to these documents? By a list of books to buy, a question at the visitation, an examination, a written *Revers* (pledge), a sworn oath, a "Yea" at ordination, or a subscription with his own hand?
- How did this differ from one territory to another, and how did it change over time? The main stages are the 1530s, the Interim years, the age of the territorial *corpora doctrinae* in the 1560s and 1570s, the Formula of Concord campaign of 1577–1580, and the refusals and Reformed reorientations that followed.
- Were lay people ever bound in the same way? This covers the profession and vow at confirmation, admission to communion, godparents, admission as a burgher, and magistrates and other officials.
- What did the orders say about refusers and dissenters?

The findings are summarised in §17.1, and the method and its cautions are described in §17.2. §17.3 is a glossary of the documents the orders name. §17.4 sets out the forms of binding. §§17.5–17.16 go through the territories region by region, each in date order. §17.17 covers the laity. §17.18 is a table by order, and §17.19 a concordance of every order quoted.

Related chapters. Several subjects are treated more fully elsewhere and are only cited here:

- the rites at which the vows were taken (confirmation, ordination, installation, and the oaths of sextons, schoolmasters, churchwardens and magistrates): Chapter 13, §§13.6, 13.10–13.13;
- the examination, trial sermon and continuing study of ministers, and the consistories that examined them: Chapter 15, §§15.5, 15.7;
- catechesis before first communion and before marriage: Chapter 15, §15.11;
- how deacons, elders and the other church offices were installed: Chapter 16, §16.8;
- what the confessional lines meant for baptism, godparents, the Supper, absolution, ordination, preaching and prayer between the traditions: Chapter 18;
- the confessional tradition of every order: Chapter 1, §1.3.

The abbreviations for the confessional writings are listed in the Conventions.

17.1 Summary of findings

17.1.1 The main findings

1. There was no single confessional standard until 1580, and not everywhere after it. Every territory had a rule of doctrine, but what that rule held varied a great deal. In outline it moved through five stages:

- **To about 1540: Scripture and the prince.** The earliest oaths bound a pastor to preach "the holy gospel and word of God" purely, together with obedience to his lord. Brandenburg-Ansbach's priest's oath of 1528 is the model (§17.14.1). Heilbronn's council swore in 1530 to stand together in matters "of the gospel" (§17.17.5). Confessions are not yet named.
- **About 1540 to 1560: the Augsburg Confession and Melanchthon.** The CA and its Apology become the measure of preaching. The orders add Melanchthon's *Loci communes* as the textbook from which ministers are examined. This is so in Albertine Saxony in 1540 and 1557 (§17.5.1), Württemberg in 1547 (§17.13.1), Pomerania (§17.7.4) and Strasbourg's examination of 1549, issued under the Interim (§17.15.1). The norm is still given chiefly as a list of books a parish must buy.
- **The 1560s and 1570s: territorial *corpora doctrinae*.** Princes and cities gathered their own bodies of doctrine, which pastors had to own, follow and often subscribe. These were the Philippist *Corpus doctrinae* (body of doctrine) of 1560 (adopted in Electoral Saxony, Kurland, Brieg, Oldenburg, Bremen and Hesse, the last two Philippist), the Pomeranian, the Prussian (1567), the Thuringian, the Wolfenbüttel *Corpus Julium* (1576), the Brunswick city corpus (1571), the Ansbach-Nürnberg *norma doctrinae* (1573) and the Hohenlohe corpus (1578). Some local confessions also served as corpora:

Mansfeld 1565, the Lüneburg Articles of 1561, Danzig's *Notel* (note) of 1562, the Strasbourg Concord of 1563 and Ravensburg's local "formula concordiae" (Formula of Concord) of 1578.

- **1577 to about 1600: the Formula and the Book of Concord.** The FC was put to every minister for signature in Electoral Saxony, Brandenburg, Württemberg, Mecklenburg, Henneberg, Mansfeld, Pfalz-Neuburg, the Upper Palatinate, Ansbach and many Swabian and Franconian cities, and it was written into church orders such as Hoya's (1581). Later orders made signing the BoC a condition of admission to office (§§17.5.3, 17.6.2, 17.9, 17.13, 17.14). Ordination questions took the FC into the vow itself, answered with "Yea" (Henneberg 1582, Waldeck, Frankfurt 1589 and Strasbourg 1598).
- **The refusers and the Reformed turn.** Some refused the FC outright: Anhalt (§17.6.6), Hesse (Philippist), Danzig, Nürnberg and its neighbours, Gottorp and the Danish lands, Colmar (Moderate Reformed) and Bremen (Philippist). Pomerania kept its own corpus and took only three points of the FC against the Calvinists, in 1593. Some ceased to require it when they turned Reformed: Kurpfalz after 1583 and the Upper Palatinate in 1585. Others kept a pre-1577 norm or replaced the FC with a local formula, such as Hohenlohe's *Gründlicher Bericht* (Thorough report) of 1603–1605. Where the Reformed took over, the CA *variata* or Scripture alone became the stated norm. The CA was understood in the Frankfurt Recess and Naumburg sense, and the Heidelberg Catechism replaced Luther's.

2. The canon grew by accretion. The usual sequence of additions to Scripture and the three creeds was:

- the CA, from 1530;
- the Apology;
- the SA, named increasingly from the 1550s, often "as signed at Smalcald 1537";
- Luther's catechisms;
- then either Melanchthon's corpus or a territorial corpus;
- and finally the FC or the whole BoC.

Many orders show this growth inside their own textual history. Ansbach's 1528 oath carries apparatus variants for 1570, 1573 and 1588 (§17.14.1). The Hohenlohe KO of 1578 gained a handwritten "7. The *formula concordiae*" (§17.13.3). The Kurpfalz formula of 1556 was rewritten in 1580 and 1586 (§17.12.1).

3. "Unaltered" and "in its true sense" are the signs of party.

- *Gnesio-Lutheran or FC party.* Adjectives such as *unverändert* (unaltered), *ungeändert* (unchanged), *uralt* (most ancient), *wie anno 30 übergeben* (as delivered in the year [15]30), "in its right, true sense" and "as explained in the Apology, the SA and the catechisms" mark the Gnesio-Lutheran or FC party. Examples are Wolfenbüttel 1569 (§17.9.1), Verden 1606, Osnabrück 1610 and Hoya 1581.
- *Philippist or Reformed party.* Phrases such as "as repeated at Frankfurt and Naumburg", the *Corpus doctrinae Philippi* (Philip's body of doctrine) and the *Repetitio* (Repetition; *Confessio Saxonica*) mark the Philippist or Reformed party. Examples are Bremen 1572 (Philippist), the Upper Palatinate 1585 (Reformed) and Kurland 1570 (Lutheran).

4. The form of binding hardened. The forms run from a book list, through a question at the visitation and a promise, to a sworn oath and a signature in one's own hand. In the oldest orders the confession appears as books a parish must buy (Ernestine Saxony 1554, Albertine Saxony 1557). Later orders demand:

- a public confession at admission (Ernestine Saxony 1569, Strasbourg from 1562);
- a written promise or *Revers* (pledge; Nassau-Diez 1564);
- an oath on the confessions (Ansbach, Peine/Gottorp 1574, Wimpfen, Hessen-Darmstadt 1617, Transylvania);
- subscription "with his own hand" (Electoral Saxony 1580, Regensburg 1572/88, Hildesheim 1593, Wimpfen).

The Kurpfalz (Lutheran and Reformed in turn) and Pfalz-Neuburg *Bestallungen* bind "with fealty given by the hand in the stead of a bodily sworn oath" (§17.12.1). §17.4 gives the forms in full.

5. Subscription reached beyond the clergy, but not to the common people. Superintendents, consistorial assessors and professors were bound as a matter of course. So in some cities were burgomasters, syndics, physicians and secretaries (Hildesheim 1593), the chamberlain and council (Regensburg 1572/88), and schoolmasters in many places. **No order requires ordinary lay people to subscribe the CA or the FC.** The laity were bound in other ways (§17.17):

- by the catechism examination before first communion and before marriage;

- by a public profession and vow at confirmation, chiefly in Hesse from 1539 and Strasbourg (both Moderate Reformed), the Reformed refugee churches and Electoral Saxony's confirmation of the baptismal faith;
- by the confession and exploration required before each communion (Schweinfurt 1543, after the CA itself);
- by rules for godparents and for admission as a burgher.

The Reformed orders alone required an explicit "confession of the Reformed doctrine" before the Supper (Nassau-Dillenburg 1582, Reformed, §17.17.2).

17.1.2 The pattern by region

Region	Before the FC	The FC and BoC	After 1580
Albertine (Electoral) Saxony	CA, Apol, *Loci* (Commonplaces); *CPhil* (1560/66)	Signed 1577; BoC signature required for office (1580)	BoC norm
Ernestine Saxony	CA, SA; Weimar *Confutationsbuch* 1558/59	Adopted 1580	BoC
Henneberg, Mansfeld, Magdeburg	Own corpora; Mansfeld confession 1565	Signed	Ordination vow includes the FC (Henneberg 1582)
Anhalt	CA 1530/33, SA, catechisms	Refused	Reformed after 1596
Silesia (Brieg)	—	—	*CPhil* and the Mecklenburg agenda named beside the CA (1592)
Prussia	*Corpus doctrinae Prutenicum* 1567	—	"Our church's unanimous Christian confession" (1584)
Danzig, Thorn	*Notel* 1562; CA and catechisms	BoC forbidden to be "canonised" (1586)	*Notel* (note)
Pomerania	*Corpus Pomeranicum* (1564); synodal promise by handshake (1574)	Not signed	Three points of the FC against the Calvinists taken by the synod (1593, from Sehling's introduction)
Kurland	*CPhil* with the SA (1570)	—	—
Mecklenburg, Rostock	CA, Apol, SA, Mecklenburg KO, Lüneburg Articles	Signed 1577	FC
Lauenburg	—	—	CA, Apol, SA, catechisms "or the FC" (1585)
Schleswig-Holstein (Gottorp)	Oath on CA, Apol, SA, catechisms (1574)	Refused (royal edict 1580)	New oath on Scripture alone (1607)
Brunswick city	City corpus 1571 (CA, Apol, SA, catechisms, against the errors condemned in the Lüneburg Articles)	The council sided against the duke over signing (Sehling's introduction)	City corpus
Wolfenbüttel	KO 1569; *Corpus Julium* 1576	—	*Corpus Julium* signed with the KO (Göttingen, 1601)

Region	Before the FC	The FC and BoC	After 1580
Lüneburg (duchy, city)	KO 1564; Lüneburg Articles 1561; city corpus with the 1548 confession (1575); *Corpus Wilhelminum* 1576	—	*Corpus Wilhelminum* still signed in the 17th century (Sehling's introduction)
Hoya	—	FC in the KO (1581)	—
Goslar, Hildesheim	—	FC and Erfurt Apology; officials sign (1593)	Lower Saxon Confession 1571 in corpus (Goslar 1591/95)
Verden, Osnabrück	—	—	CA "as explained" by Apol, SA, catechisms (1606); CA, Wittenberg Concord, SA, BoC (1610)
Oldenburg	CA, Apol, SA, catechism and *CPhil* (1573)	FC added in *Bestallungen* (1586)	FC; anti-Calvinist visitation 1609
Bremen (Philippist 1556–1575; Reformed from 1582)	CA, *CPhil*, Frankfurt Recess	Refused	Reformed
East Frisia	—	FC in a Lutheran congregation (1583)	Only "the CA" by treaty (1599; a Reformed–Lutheran treaty)
Soest	—	—	Corpus includes the FC; subscription required (1590)
Hesse (Moderate Reformed to 1566, then Philippist; after the division Hessen-Kassel Reformed, Hessen-Darmstadt Lutheran)	CA, Apol, SA, catechism, *CPhil* (1571)	Rejected jointly by the landgraves (editors' account; but see Darmstadt, §17.11)	Variant positions; Darmstadt oath on the unaltered CA (1617); Kassel anti-ubiquity oath (1598)
Waldeck, Frankfurt	—	FC in the ordination vow	—
Nassau (Dillenburg Reformed from 1581)	*Revers* (pledge) on CA and *Loci* (1564)	Not adopted	Reformed (Dillenburg 1582); Weilburg unaltered CA
Kurpfalz (Lutheran 1556 and 1576–1583; Reformed 1563–1576 and from 1583)	CA, Apol, SA, catechism (1556)	BoC (1580)	BoC dropped; Heidelberg Catechism (1586, Reformed)
Upper Palatinate	—	Signed 1581/82	Released 1585, Reformed; CA *variata*
Pfalz-Neuburg	CA, Apol, Wittenberg Concord, SA (1564/1576)	Signed	—
Pfalz-Zweibrücken (Reformed from 1588), Sponheim	Latin subscription formula 1564	Zweibrücken refused	Sponheim takes the FC as a "symbol" (1608)
Württemberg	CA, Apol, *Loci* (1547); Württemberg Confession (1552/59)	Mandate to sign 1577	FC
Hohenlohe	Own corpus (1578)	Added by hand	*Gründlicher Bericht* 1603/05; FC restored 1630

Region	Before the FC	The FC and BoC	After 1580
Swabian cities	Ravensburg local formula 1578	Hall, Wimpfen, Lindau, Memmingen and others sign	—
Ansbach	Oath on the gospel (1528); Ansbach-Nürnberg *norma* 1573	BoC in the oath (1588)	BoC "our *corpus doctrinae*" (1594)
Nürnberg	*Norma doctrinae* 1573	Refused	*Norma doctrinae*
Regensburg	CA, Apol, SA (1567)	BoC signed by every minister (1572/88)	BoC
Strasbourg (Moderate Reformed to 1548)	CA (1549, under the Interim); CA and Apol "*stipulata manu*" (1562); Concord 1563	FC "*corde et manu*" (1577)	FC in the ordination question (1598)
Colmar (Moderate Reformed from 1578)	Oath on Scripture, Fathers, CA and Apol (1575)	Refused (1578)	—
Transylvania	Oath on the CA (Burzenland 1573)	—	Superintendent's oath on CA, SA and the creeds (1601)

17.2 Scope, sources and method

17.2.1 What was searched

The whole of `eko.db` was searched for the vocabulary of confessional obligation:

- the names of the confessions, in German and Latin and with their OCR variants (*augspurgische confession*, *apologia*, *schmalkaldische artikel*, *catechismus Lutheri*, *formula concordiae*, *concordienbuch*, *corpus doctrinae*, *norma doctrinae*, *loci communes*, *repetitio*);
- the verbs of binding (*unterschreiben*, *subscribieren*, *schwören*, *geloben*, *angeloben*, *verpflichten*, *zusagen*, *Revers*, *Eid*, *Pflicht*, *iuramentum*, *subscribo*, *promitto*);
- the occasions of binding: ordination, examination, vocation, *Bestallung* (appointment), visitation, synod, admission to the consistory, and appointment as schoolmaster, superintendent or assessor.

Every hit was read in context. Each was sorted by whether it was the text of an order, Sehling's introduction or a footnote. For the laity the search covered confirmation, first communion, admission to the Supper (*exploration*, *verhör*), godparents (*gevattern*, *paten*, *susceptores*), admission as burgher (*bürger*, *hintersäß*), and oaths of councils and officials.

17.2.2 What the chapter does not do

- It does not give the full text of each confession, nor the history of the FC's making. It records only what the church orders themselves say.
- It does not list every signature. The great lists of subscribers in the archives are beyond the edition. Sehling sometimes reports their numbers, for example 444 signatures in Mecklenburg in 1577 (Sehling 5, pp. 142–143), and these are noted where he does.
- **A book list is not a subscription.** Many orders tell a parish to buy the CA, the *Loci* (Commonplaces) or a *Corpus doctrinae* (body of doctrine), and tell the pastor to read it. That makes the book a standard of preaching, but it is not an oath or a signature. Where an order lists books only, this is said.
- **A territorial norm is not always a personal obligation.** A preface may say that "our churches" hold the CA without saying how a pastor was bound to it. The chapter marks which kind of statement each quotation is.

17.2.3 Cautions

- **Sehling's introductions and apparatus.** Several of the best statements about subscription, such as the Hildesheim decision of 1593 or the Anhalt refusal of the FC (Anhalt was still Lutheran), are found only in Sehling's introductions or footnotes, which quote or summarise archival sources. They are marked as such.
- **Apparatus variants.** Some orders were reissued, and the editors print the later wording in the apparatus. Examples are the Ansbach priest's oath (1528, with forms of 1570, 1573 and 1588), the Hohenlohe KO of 1578 (with a handwritten addition naming the FC) and the Kurpfalz KO of 1556 (with variants of 1577). These are quoted as variants with their dates.
- **Record headings.** The database's record headings sometimes name the first order in a volume section rather than the order on the page. So document 1844 is headed "This first Danzig order … 1557", but its p. 234 is the Thorn KO of 1575, and its p. 210 the Danzig KO of 1612. Each order is named here from Sehling's running head. Where the running head is itself misleading, this is said (as at Anhalt, p. 579, where a passage of the 1588 *Instructio* runs onto a page headed with the next order).
- **OCR errors.** OCR errors are quoted as printed. Thus Calenberg's "Gorpus doctrinae Julium" is printed as such, and the Kassel KO of 1539 (Moderate Reformed) carries the running head "1589".

17.2.4 How to read the regional sections

Each regional section goes through its orders in date order. For each it says:

- **what the norm was**: which documents the order names, in what order, and with what qualifiers ("unaltered", "as delivered in 1530", "in its true sense");
- **who was bound**: ordinands, pastors, superintendents, schoolmasters, assessors, councils;
- **how they were bound**: book list, visitation question, examination, promise, *Revers* (pledge), oath, ordination "Yea", or subscription.

The table in §17.18 gathers these by order.

17.3 The documents the orders name

This glossary gives the documents in the form the orders name them. Where an order's wording identifies a particular edition or reading (the *invariata* [unaltered] or the *variata*, the first print of the Apology), this is noted. For dates and contents the standard editions are the *Bekenntnisschriften der evangelisch-lutherischen Kirche* (Confessional writings of the Evangelical Lutheran Church) (BSLK, BSELK), which the editors of the later volumes cite in their footnotes.

17.3.1 The ancient creeds

- **The three creeds** (*drei Hauptsymbola*, *symbola oecumenica*): the Apostles', the Nicene and the Athanasian. They come first after Scripture in almost every list.
- **The four councils** (Nicaea, Constantinople, Ephesus and Chalcedon). These are named in Kurland (1570), the Katzenelnbogen pastors' oath (1598, Philippist, together with Leo's Tome to Flavian), Strasbourg (1598) and the Upper Palatinate (1585, Reformed). In Hessen-Kassel and the Upper Palatinate they are aimed against the ubiquity doctrine.

17.3.2 The Lutheran confessions

- **Augsburg Confession (CA), 1530.** Named in nearly every order from the 1530s on. The qualifiers matter:
  - *wie anno 30 übergeben* (as delivered in the year [15]30), *ungeändert* (unchanged), *unverändert* (unaltered), *uralt* (most ancient), *rein, unverfälscht* (pure, unadulterated), *invariata* (unaltered), "the first edition";
  - against "as repeated at Frankfurt and Naumburg" (§17.12.2) and the *variata* of 1540. Ansbach (1573) names both "the last" and "the first edition" as signed at Naumburg in 1561 (§17.14.1).
- **Apology of the CA (Apol).** Usually paired with the CA. Goslar names it "in the first print" (§17.9.6). Anhalt dates the CA and the Apology "in the year [15]30 and [15]33" (§17.6.6).
- **Smalcald Articles (SA), 1537.** Often "written by Dr Luther for the council at Mantua, and subscribed at Smalcald" (Albertine Saxony 1580, Ernestine Saxony 1569).
- **Luther's Small and Large Catechisms (SC, LC).** Hoya calls them "the laymen's Bible" (§17.9.5).
- **Wittenberg Concord, 1536.** Named in Pfalz-Neuburg (1564) and in Osnabrück (1610), which calls it "*Formula Concordiae*, set up in the year 1536". This should not be confused with the FC of 1577.

- **Formula of Concord (FC), 1577, and the Book of Concord (BoC), 1580.** The FC is also called the *Bergisches Buch* (Bergen Book), the *einigungs und erklerungs notel* (note of agreement and explanation; Henneberg), the *einigungs formul* (formula of agreement; Henneberg, Waldeck) and the *Concordibuch* (Book of Concord). The BoC is the whole corpus printed in 1580.
- **Erfurt Apology of the BoC, 1582.** Signed with the FC in Hildesheim (§17.10.1).

17.3.3 Melanchthon and the Philippist corpora

- ***Loci communes*.** Melanchthon's doctrinal handbook. It was the examination textbook in Albertine Saxony (1540), Württemberg (*Loci recentiores*, 1547), Pomerania, Nassau-Diez (1564) and Ansbach (1573).
- ***Repetitio* or *Confessio Saxonica*, 1551.** Written for the Council of Trent. Albertine Saxony (1557), Ansbach (1573) and Bremen (1570, Philippist) name it.
- ***Examen ordinandorum*** (Melanchthon's examination of ordinands, 1552) and the ***Responsiones* to the Bavarian articles**.
- ***Corpus doctrinae Philippicum* (or *Misnicum*), 1560.** Melanchthon's collected doctrinal works, printed by Vögelin in Leipzig. It was official in Electoral Saxony until 1574 and was adopted in Kurland (1570), Silesia (Brieg 1592), Oldenburg (1573), Bremen (1570–1575) and Hesse (1571), both Philippist, and Pfalz-Zweibrücken.

17.3.4 Territorial corpora and local confessions

- ***Corpus doctrinae Pomeranicum*** (1564): Melanchthon's works with Luther's catechisms and confession, in Low German and Latin (§17.7.4).
- ***Corpus doctrinae Prutenicum*** (1567), the Prussian corpus (§17.7.2).
- ***Corpus doctrinae Thuringicum*** (1570), and the Weimar *Confutationsbuch* (1558/59) against the sects, which Ernestine Saxony made binding in 1569 (§17.6.1).
- ***Corpus doctrinae Julium*** (Wolfenbüttel, 1576), signed in Calenberg-Göttingen (§17.9.4).
- ***Corpus doctrinae Wilhelminum*** (Lüneburg, 1576). This is named only in Sehling's introduction (Sehling 6/1, pp. 487–489).
- **The Brunswick city corpus** (1571) (§17.9.2).
- **The Lüneburg Articles** (1561), against the Philippists. Rostock (1573) names them, and Brunswick (1571) condemns what they condemn.
- **The confession of Lübeck, Hamburg and Lüneburg against the Interim** (1548). Part of the Lüneburg city corpus (1575).
- **The Lower Saxon Confession** (1571). In Goslar's corpus (1591/95).
- **The Mansfeld confession** (1565) (§17.6.3).
- **The Danzig *Notel*** (1562). The city's own formula, signed by its clergy (§17.7.3).
- **The Ansbach-Nürnberg *Norma doctrinae*** (1573) (§17.14.1).
- **The Strasbourg Concord** (1563) (§17.15).
- **The Ravensburg "formula concordiae"** (1578, renewed 1617), a local formula of the city's preachers (§17.13.5).
- **The Württemberg Confession** (*Confessio Virtembergica*), presented at Trent in 1552 (§17.13.1).
- **The Hohenlohe *Gründlicher Bericht*** (1603/05), which took the place of the FC (§17.13.3).
- **The Confessio Anhaltina** and the Anhalt Supper confession of 1585. These are named in Sehling's introduction (§17.6.6).

17.3.5 Reformed documents

- **The Heidelberg Catechism** (1563, Reformed), which replaced Luther's catechism in the Reformed Kurpfalz *Bestallung* (appointment) of 1586 (§17.12.1).
- **The CA as "repeated" at Frankfurt (1558) and Naumburg (1561)**: the CA read in the *variata* sense, in the Upper Palatinate (1585, Reformed) and in Bremen (the Frankfurt Recess, 1575, Philippist).
- **"The confession of the Reformed doctrine"** required for admission to the Supper in Nassau-Dillenburg (1582, Reformed) (§17.17.2).

17.4 The forms of binding

The orders bind ministers to their confessions in seven ways. They range from the weakest, a list of books, to the strongest, an oath confirmed by one's own signature. Most orders use several of them at once.

1. **The book list.** The parish must buy the named books, keep them in the inventory, and the pastor must read them. Examples are Ernestine Saxony 1554, Albertine Saxony 1540 and 1557, Pomerania 1563/69 and Brieg 1592 (§§17.5.1, 17.6.1, 17.7.1, 17.7.4). It sets a standard of preaching but requires no personal act.
2. **The visitation question.** The visitor asks the pastor whether he holds the named confessions as his *norma doctrinae* and renounces all contrary opinions. Examples are Henneberg 1574, Magdeburg 1583 and Nassau-Weilburg 1576 (§§17.6.2, 17.6.4, 17.11.5).
3. **The examination.** The candidate is examined from the *Loci* (Commonplaces), the CA or the corpus. Examples are Württemberg 1547, Strasbourg 1549 and Ansbach 1594, where he must first have read the whole BoC (§§17.13.1, 17.15.1, 17.14.1).
4. **The promise, *Revers* or *Bestallung*.** The minister promises in writing or by handshake to teach according to the named books. Examples:
    - the Nassau-Diez *Revers* (1564, §17.11.4);
    - the Pomeranian synodal formula "*per dexteram societatis*" (1574, §17.7.4);
    - the Kurpfalz *Bestallungen* "with fealty given by the hand in the stead of a bodily sworn oath" (1580–1601, Lutheran in 1580 and Reformed from 1586, §17.12.1).
5. **The oath.** The minister swears by God's name to the named books. Examples:
    - Ansbach, *glob und schwer* (1528 and later, §17.14.1);
    - the Peine and Gottorp preachers' oath (1574, §§17.8.4, 17.10.1);
    - the Wimpfen *iuramentum* (oath; after 1577, §17.13.5);
    - Colmar (1575, §17.15.3);
    - Hessen-Darmstadt (1617, §17.11.1);
    - the Transylvanian superintendent (1601, §17.16). The Hohenlohe oath of 1588 swears to the church order rather than to named confessions (§17.13.3).
6. **The ordination vow.** At the laying on of hands the ordinand is asked whether he will direct his faith and confession by the named books and answers "Yea". This is so in Henneberg 1582, Waldeck, Frankfurt 1589 and Strasbourg 1598 (§§17.6.2, 17.11.2, 17.11.3, 17.15.2). In Mecklenburg in 1552 the promise is to remain in "the pure Christian doctrine which he hath confessed in this hearing", and no book is named (§17.8.1).
7. **Subscription.** The minister signs the corpus or the FC "with his own hand". Examples:
    - Albertine Saxony 1580 (§17.5.3);
    - Brunswick 1571 (§17.9.2);
    - Regensburg 1572/88 (§17.14.3);
    - Strasbourg "*corde et manu*" 1577 (§17.15.2);
    - Hildesheim 1593 (§17.10.1);
    - Soest 1590 (§17.10.7);
    - Schwäbisch Hall 1614/15 (§17.13.5);
    - Wimpfen's *Notula subscriptionis* (§17.13.5);
    - Pfalz-Zweibrücken's Latin "I subscribe with mind and hand" of 1564 (§17.12.4).

Who was bound. Pastors and preachers come first. The orders regularly add:

- deacons, chaplains and schoolmasters (Hildesheim, Kurpfalz 1601 (Reformed), Hessen-Darmstadt);
- superintendents (Wild- und Rheingrafschaft 1576, Transylvania 1601);
- consistorial presidents and assessors (Ernestine Saxony 1569, Prussia 1584, Ansbach 1594);
- professors (Hessen-Darmstadt 1617);
- in cities, the council itself (Regensburg 1572), and burgomasters, syndics, physicians and secretaries (Hildesheim 1593).

For the laity see §17.17.

The ordination and installation rites in which the vows were taken are given in Chapter 13, §§13.10–13.11.

17.5 Albertine (Electoral) Saxony

Albertine Saxony moved further than any other territory: from the CA and Melanchthon's *Loci* (1540), through the *Corpus doctrinae Philippicum* (official from 1566 by Sehling's account, Sehling 1, pp. 124–125), to the Book of Concord. In 1580 a signature to the BoC was the condition of admission to every parish.

17.5.1 The CA and the *Loci* as a book list (1540, 1557)

The visitors' general instruction of 1540 tells pastors to preach nothing but what agrees with the CA and Apology, and to buy the books by which they will be measured. **Albertine Saxony, *Gemeiner bericht der visitatorn an die pfarrer und dorfschaften*, 1540** (Sehling 1, p. 285):

And lastly let them teach nothing else than that which is agreeable to the confession and apology delivered to his imperial majesty at Augsburg, and above all to the holy gospel; whereto it will be needful that they buy for themselves the Bible and the same confession, etc., the *Loci communes* of Dr Philip, Luther's postil, and other Christian pure books, and study diligently therein.

By 1557 the parish was to buy the *Repetitio* (Repetition; *Confessio Saxonica*) of 1551 with the CA. **Albertine Saxony, *General-Artikel und gemeiner Bericht*, 8 May 1557** (Sehling 1, p. 325):

He shall urge the churchwardens that they buy out of the church's income a German Bible, the Augsburg Confession and the repetition thereof above mentioned, the agenda, and also the German *Loci communes*, which shall remain with the parish and be written into the inventory; and the same shall he and the sexton be bound diligently to read.

The norm here is wholly Melanchthonian. The CA is read with its *Repetitio* and the *Loci* (Commonplaces); the Smalcald Articles are not named.

17.5.2 The *Corpus doctrinae Philippicum* (1560–1574)

The 1560 *Corpus doctrinae* (body of doctrine; §17.3.3) was the official norm in Electoral Saxony from 1566 until the fall of the Philippists in 1574 (Sehling's introduction, Sehling 1, pp. 124–125). Outside Saxony it was named as a norm in Kurland, Silesia, Oldenburg, Bremen and Hesse, and Melanchthon's *Loci* (Commonplaces) in Nassau (§§17.7.1, 17.8.2, 17.10.4, 17.10.5, 17.11.1, 17.11.4).

17.5.3 The Book of Concord as the condition of office (1580)

Elector August's church order of 1580 makes a signature to the BoC the condition of being sent to a parish. **Electoral Saxony, *Kirchenordnung* of Elector August, 1580** (Sehling 1, p. 380):

When a person, after the examination held and the trial sermon done, is found fit for the ministry of the church, and is orderly called and summoned by the church, and hath also subscribed the Book of Concord with his own hand, so that he may be trusted as touching doctrine, then before his final dispatch to the parish appointed the admonition following shall be earnestly set before him by the president or director of the consistory.

The same order sets out the whole norm, in the sequence that became standard. The Smalcald Articles are now in, and the *Corpus Philippicum* is gone (Sehling 1, p. 420):

It is our earnest will and meaning that henceforth in all the churches of our electorate and lands, as we declared at the beginning in the preface to this ordinance, all pastors and ministers of the church shall in all things behave themselves according to none other than the Biblical, prophetic and apostolic Scriptures; and after them according to the unaltered confession and the apology that followed thereon; and the articles written by Dr Luther at Smalcald, approved and subscribed by the chief theologians there assembled, which were to have been delivered to the council at Mantua; and also both Christian catechisms of Dr Luther; and the unanimous declaration and Christian explanation of all the articles in controversy, lately drawn up thereupon at Torgau and afterwards amended from the judgments brought in from all other churches; and shall teach nothing contrary to the same, neither secretly nor openly.

The FC is not named by its title. It is described as the declaration made at Torgau and amended from the judgments of the other churches. The same order's teaching on confirmation is quoted in §17.17.1.

17.6 Ernestine Saxony, Henneberg, the Harz counties, Magdeburg, Halberstadt and Anhalt

The Ernestine dukes were the Gnesio-Lutheran counterweight to Albertine Saxony. Their norm adds the Smalcald Articles early, and in 1569 the Weimar *Confutationsbuch* against the "sects". Around them the smaller territories of central Germany

(Henneberg, Mansfeld, the archbishopric of Magdeburg, Halberstadt) followed with local confessions and, after 1577, with the FC. Anhalt alone refused it.

17.6.1 Ernestine Saxony: from the book list to the public confession (1554, 1569)

The 1554 instruction puts the Smalcald Articles beside the CA in the parish's library. **Ernestine Saxony, *Instruction Johans Friderichen des mittlern, Johans Wilhelm und Johans Friderichen d. j.*, 1554** (Sehling 1, p. 227):

the visitors shall order with the churchwardens of every place that they buy out of the church's or other common goods a German Bible and Doctor Luther's house postil, the Augsburg Confession, the Smalcald Articles, [which] Luther [made] for the council at Mantua in the year 38, together with the Instruction of the Visitors, which likewise came forth lastly in the year 38; and endow them in perpetuity to the parish, and write them into the parish inventory.

By 1569 no one could sit in the consistory at Jena unless he openly confessed the norm and condemned the errors named in the ducal *Confutationes* (Confutations) of 1558. **Ernestine Saxony, *Ordnung und reformation ecclesiastici consistorii zu Jena*, 1569** (Sehling 1, p. 234):

it is our mind and meaning, and we will, that no person be received thereto nor suffered, except he be of a Christian and honest conversation, and confess himself openly and clearly to the holy Scripture of the Old and New Testaments; to the three creeds, the Apostolic, the Nicene and Athanasius's; to the Augsburg Confession, as it was delivered in the year 30 to the emperor Charles the Fifth by our lord grandfather and gracious lord father, Duke John and Duke John Frederick of Saxony, electors of most laudable Christian memory, and certain other princes and cities; together with the apology thereof; and also to the articles which the aforenamed Dr Martin Luther of blessed memory set forth for the council at Mantua [...]; and except he gainsay all old and new sects and corruptions which are contrary to God's pure word, and especially those that are comprehended in our princely confutations, which came forth in print after the synod held at Weimar in the year 1558.

This is the first order in this chapter to make a **negative** confession part of the obligation. The minister must not only hold the books but condemn, by name, the errors a particular book condemns. Brunswick (1571, §17.9.2), Regensburg (1567, §17.14.3) and Hessen-Darmstadt (1617, §17.11.1) do the same. In 1580 the Ernestine pastors were told to read the coming Book of Concord, on which they would be examined (Sehling 1, p. 254).

17.6.2 Henneberg: the visitation question, subscription and the ordination vow (1574–1582)

The Henneberg visitation of 1574/77 asks every pastor whether he holds the confessions as his *norma doctrinae*. **Henneberg, *Visitations- und Consistorial-Ordnung*, 1574, 1577** (Sehling 2, p. 291):

The pastor of every place is first to be asked whether he, with his faith, doctrine and confession, assenteth wholly to the holy divine Scripture, the three chief creeds, the Augsburg Confession, the Apology, the Smalcald Articles and Luther's catechism, in their right, natural and plain sense, and will hold them *pro norma doctrinae* (as the norm of doctrine) and continue steadfastly therein, and on the other hand renounce all contrary opinions.

The church order of 1582 recalls that Henneberg's ministers had always been "appointed, examined, ordained and made to subscribe" on these books, and lately also on the FC. **Henneberg, *Des durchlauchtigen hochgebornen fürsten und herrn, herrn Georg Ernsten, kirchen ordnung*, 1582** (Sehling 2, p. 300):

[we have] at all times held such books and writings for the norm of our churches, and have also caused our ministers of the church to be appointed, examined, ordained, and to subscribe thereupon [...]; as we also, together with the ministers of the church of our princely county, have lately referred and drawn ourselves likewise to this same norm in the subscription of the common note of union and declaration, otherwise called the Formula of Concord, as that which hath flowed from the same ground.

The same order puts the whole norm, the FC included, into the ordination itself. The ordinand answers "Yea" before hands are laid on him (Sehling 2, p. 324):

Will ye now keep that which hath been set before you at length out of God's word, and the further measure given you therein for your office; but especially direct your faith and confession according to God's word, as the same is contained in the prophetic and apostolic holy Scripture, and likewise according to the three chief creeds, and the true, well-grounded Augsburg Confession taken therefrom, the Apology, the Smalcald Articles, Luther's Small and Large Catechism, together with the present Christian

formula of union? Then promise it hereby to God and his holy Christian church, and to us by virtue of our office. Answer: Yea. So we commit unto you the office of the holy gospel, in the name of God the Father, the Son and the Holy Ghost, amen. *Lay on hands.*

Waldeck copied this question word for word (§17.11.2).

17.6.3 Mansfeld: the county's own confession of 1565 and the Book of Concord (1580, 1586)

Mansfeld's corpus included its own confession of 1565. **Mansfeld, *Kirchen-agenda für die prediger der grafschaft Mansfeld*, 1580** (Sehling 2, p. 215):

But as touching doctrine, we testify also hereby briefly and openly that by God's grace we continue steadfastly in the true and right unanimity of the orthodox Christian church of God, as the same is comprehended and set down in the unchangeable word of Almighty God, the holy Scripture, that is, in the books of the holy prophets and apostles; in the universal creeds, the Apostolic, the Athanasian and the Nicene; in the first, pure, unaltered Augsburg Confession, as it was delivered at Augsburg in the year 1530 to the late emperor Charles the Fifth, etc.; in the Apology thereof; in the Smalcald Articles; in the two catechisms, the Large and the Small; and in the other writings of the dear man of God, Luther; and also in our confessions that have come forth in open print, especially those of the year 1565.

The consistory order of 1586 then sets the BoC beside the county's own confession as the rule by which disputes are decided. **Mansfeld, *Gräflich mansfeldische geistliche consistorial ordnung*, 1586** (Sehling 2, p. 201):

then shall the same be discussed and decided out of the holy Bible, the writings of the prophets and apostles, out of the creeds and confessions of the true church, out of the Augsburg Confession and Apology, out of Dr Luther's writings and catechisms, [and] out of our church's confession that came forth in the year 1565. And forasmuch as the Book of Concord that came forth in print in the year 1585 [variant: 1580] agreeth with this norm just now named and recounted, and we have caused the same to be deposited and laid up in all our churches throughout the whole county, and the pastors to be commanded to teach thereafter,

The consistory was to admit no one who "will not be at one with the others" in this norm.

17.6.4 Archbishopric of Magdeburg: the visitation question (1583)

The archbishopric's visitation instruction of 1583 calls the confessions "the right *corpus doctrinae*", and makes the FC rest on them. **Archbishopric of Magdeburg, *Instruktion zur Visitation*, 25 May 1583** (Sehling 2, p. 419):

Which common public writings and confessions, beside the prophetic and apostolic Scriptures and the three chief creeds, are the right *corpus doctrinae* (body of doctrine), that is, the summary content, pattern and rule of pure doctrine. Whether he himself holdeth and believeth, and propoundeth and teacheth to the church committed to him, his doctrine in all his public sermons, and also in instructing the weak in faith and the sick, according to the prophetic and apostolic Scriptures, the three chief creeds, the unaltered Augsburg Confession which was delivered to Charles the Fifth in the year 30, the Apology thereof, the Smalcald Articles, and Luther's Large and Small Catechisms, upon which the Formula of Concord published in the year 80 is grounded.

17.6.5 Halberstadt: the Brunswick corpus (1588)

Halberstadt, ruled by the Wolfenbüttel dukes as administrators, takes over the *Corpus doctrinae* (body of doctrine) printed in the Brunswick church order. **Bishopric of Halberstadt, *Instruktion für die Visitation*, 8 August 1588** (Sehling 2, pp. 468–469):

and besides, not only diligently to read and get into their heads the Bible, the Augsburg Confession, the Apology thereof, the Smalcald Articles, Luther's catechisms, and also the *corpus doctrinae* (body of doctrine) in the Brunswick church order, but also to order their sermons according to the rule and line thereof.

17.6.6 Anhalt: the refusal

Anhalt never signed the FC. By Sehling's account, Prince Joachim Ernst "could not be moved" to sign it. From 1578 Anhalt's ordinands were no longer sent to Wittenberg but ordained at Zerbst (Sehling 2, pp. 525, 528–529). After his death the visitation instruction of 1588 still named a norm without the FC. It dates the CA and the Apology "in the year [15]30 and [15]33" and names the late Prince Wolfgang's signature to them. **Anhalt, *Instructio commissariorum in potestate executionis der vorgenommenen Visitation*, 21 September 1588** (Sehling 2, p. 579, a page that bears the running head of the next order):

that they may have one norm of Christian doctrine and confession, we name to them for that purpose the following books: namely the holy Bible of the Old and New Testaments; the three chief creeds, the Apostolic, the Nicene and the Athanasian; the Augsburg Confession and the Apology thereof, as they were delivered in the years 30 and 33 to the emperor Charles the Fifth of most laudable Christian memory, and came forth in open print, which also the late high-born prince, Lord Wolfgang, prince of Anhalt, etc., of most laudable and blessed Christian memory, etc., subscribed with his own hand beside other electors, princes and estates; the Smalcald Articles made by Dr Martin Luther in the year 37; and the said doctor's Small and Large Catechisms; which they shall hold *pro confessione* (as a confession) and as the norm of sound words, and abide therein in Christian simplicity.

The canon here is that of the 1570s, before the FC: CA, Apol, SA and the catechisms. It is held "*pro confessione*", not signed.

17.7 Silesia, Prussia, the Polish cities and Pomerania

The eastern territories kept to the norms they had made before the FC. Brieg in Silesia still named the *Corpus Philippicum* in 1592. Prussia had its own *Corpus doctrinae* (body of doctrine) of 1567. The cities of Royal Prussia had a corpus confirmed by the Polish king, and Danzig a city formula, the *Notel* (note). Pomerania had a Melanchthonian corpus of its own. None of the orders quoted here makes the FC a condition of office, and Danzig forbade it to be "canonised".

17.7.1 Silesia: Brieg (1592)

The Brieg church order of 1592 names, beside the CA and Apology, Luther's writings, the *Corpus doctrinae Philippi* (Philip's body of doctrine) and the Mecklenburg agenda. **Brieg, *Kirchenordnung für Brieg*, 1592** (Sehling 3, pp. 444–445):

Touching doctrine: this shall be carried on pure, without erroneous opinion, as it is comprehended in the prophetic and apostolic Scriptures and the approved creeds, whose ground and content [is set down] in the Augsburg Confession and its Apology, in the writings of Luther, the *corpus doctrinae* (body of doctrine) of Philip, the Mecklenburg agenda, and whatsoever agreeth herewith; and [so shall it be] planted, so far as the time [alloweth].

A later chapter of the same order, headed *De corpore doctrinae* (Of the body of doctrine), tells every preacher what to read. The database files this page under the next territory, Jägerndorf, but it is the end of the Brieg order (Sehling 3, p. 448):

Of the corpus doctrinae. Every preacher in towns and villages shall have, beside the holy Bible, and diligently read, the *Corpus doctrinae* (body of doctrine) of Philip Melanchthon, the postils of Master Luther, the Tomes of Luther and of Philip, and also the fitting writings of other learned men.

This is a book list, not a subscription.

17.7.2 Ducal Prussia: the *Corpus doctrinae Prutenicum* (1567) and the assessors' oath (1584)

Prussia's corpus of 1567 was made after the Osiandrian controversy. Pastors are to keep strictly to it. **Prussia, *Von Erwehlung der beiden bischoff*, 1568** (Sehling 4, p. 111):

Therein they shall abide strictly by the *Corpus doctrinae* (body of doctrine), as the same was gathered together and published in this duchy in the year 1567 out of the prophetic and apostolic Scriptures, the ancient creeds, and also the doctrine of Luther; and they shall especially imprint the holy catechism of Luther very diligently upon the people.

The consistory order of 1584 binds its president and assessors by oath to "our church's unanimous Christian confession", without naming its parts. **Prussia, *Consistorialordnung*, 1584** (Sehling 4, p. 125):

Oath of the president and of the assessors. I swear that in all and every matter coming before this consistory I will, together with the other assessors appointed thereto, faithfully and diligently, according to my best understanding and ability, counsel, consider, seek and help to further that which is agreeable to the saving divine word, to our church's unanimous Christian confession, to honesty, and to the written laws,

17.7.3 Thorn, Elbing and Danzig: a royal corpus and the city *Notel* (1575, 1586, 1612)

The three great cities of Royal Prussia needed the king's leave for their religion. Thorn's church order names the corpus that King Sigismund Augustus had allowed them: Luther's two catechisms and the CA, "given both to teachers and hearers". **Thorn,**

***Kirchenordnung für Thorn*, 1575** (Sehling 4, p. 234):

Therefore the said magistrates have held it profitable and needful to set before their churches a certain *corpus doctrinae* (body of doctrine), gathered out of the writings of the holy prophets and apostles, namely Luther's Small and Large Catechism and the Augsburg Confession; which also Sigismund Augustus, king of Poland, of most laudable and blessed memory, [our] most gracious lord, most graciously permitted and allowed to the three cities of Thorn, Elbing and Danzig upon their humble and earnest suit; wherefore it hath also been given both to the teachers and to the hearers, to hold fast by the said *corpus doctrinae* and to change nothing therein.

Danzig had besides its own formula, the *Notel* (note) of 1562, signed by its clergy. By Sehling's account it remained the city's confessional basis until 1793 (Sehling 4, p. 172). When the FC came, the council forbade it. **Danzig, *Decret des Senats*, 23 October 1586** (Sehling 4, p. 192):

[they] shall use no manner nor form of speech that striveth against the Augsburg Confession and the *Notel*. Neither shall the writings of Calvin [or] Zwingli, the Book of Concord and the like books be canonised, or in the least defended, by any of the lords preachers, either publicly or privately; much less shall any controversial writings whatsoever be brought by them into this city or church.

The Book of Concord is here set beside Calvin and Zwingli as a party book. In 1612 the norm was still the CA of 1530 and the *Notel*, which each preacher had signed. **Danzig, *Kirchenordnung für Danzig*, 1612** (Sehling 4, p. 210):

As touching the doctrine and preaching office of these four preachers, they are all bound in duty, according to their appointment, to teach, to preach and to administer the most worthy sacraments according to the truth of God's word once known and confessed, after the content of the prophetic and apostolic Scriptures, of the confession delivered once for all by the protesting estates to the emperor Charles the Fifth at Augsburg in the year 1530, and of the city's formula of concord or *Notel*, subscribed by themselves.

Here "formula concordiae" (Formula of Concord) means Danzig's own *Notel*, not the FC of 1577.

17.7.4 Pomerania: the Melanchthonian corpus (1563/69) and the synodal handshake (1574)

The Pomeranian order refers its churches to Luther's writings and to Melanchthon's *Loci* (Commonplaces) and Apology. It requires every parish to buy the book in which Melanchthon's works are printed "together with the catechisms and confession of Luther", the *Corpus doctrinae Pomeranicum*. **Pomerania, *Kerckenordeninge*, 1569** (Sehling 4, p. 382):

These and other articles of Christian doctrine shall be purely and diligently taught in the churches of our lands, and further explained, in the sense in which they are expounded and set down here and there by Doctor Martin Luther in his writings, and by Philip Melanchthon in the *Loci communes* and in the Apology of the Augsburg Confession; whereunto the Pomeranian churches refer themselves, and offer [themselves] to further declaration. And forasmuch as the chief articles of our true Christian doctrine of the gospel have been comprehended and set down by the reverend Philip Melanchthon, with the counsel of Martin Luther of blessed memory and other chief theologians, in certain books, very rightly, godly and Christianly, and have already before been printed together into one book, together with the catechisms and confession of Luther, at our command and ordinance: we will, ordain and command herewith that in every parish church in our lands, in towns or villages, the aforesaid books […] shall be bought and kept, and diligently read by the ministers of the church.

The personal bond came at the synod, by a handshake modelled on Galatians 2:9. The minister promises obedience to the superintendent and synod "in retaining the godly consensus of heavenly doctrine". No confession is named. **Pomerania, *Statuta synodica*, 1574** (Sehling 4, p. 492):

Form of the obedience and fidelity of the pastors and all ministers of the church, to be performed in the synod, the right hand of fellowship being given, which the apostles also used among themselves, Gal. 2, verse 9. I, N. N., promise by the right hand of fellowship obedience and fidelity to our reverend superintendent and to the venerable synod of N., in retaining the godly consensus of heavenly doctrine, in rightly performing the whole ministry, in governing the manners of life, in maintaining union and concord, and in all things according to the statutes of the synod, the church order and the agenda. All which I will perform faithfully with a good […] conscience, as far as I am able and know, and will not be a false brother.

Pomerania never adopted the FC as such. By Sehling's account a ducal mandate of 10 May 1593 accepted only "the synodal decision in three chief points out of the *Formula Concordiae* against the Calvinists" (Sehling 4, p. 321).

17.8 Mecklenburg, Kurland, Lauenburg and Schleswig-Holstein

The Baltic territories show the widest spread of all:

- **Mecklenburg** signed the FC in 1577.
- **Kurland** bound its preachers to the Wittenberg *Corpus Philippicum* in 1570.
- **Lauenburg** (1585) named the FC as an alternative ("or").
- **Gottorp**, under the Danish king's lead, rejected the Concord. It bound its preachers by oath to the CA, Apology, SA and catechisms in 1574, and then in 1607 to Scripture alone.

17.8.1 Mecklenburg and Rostock (1552, 1573)

Mecklenburg's church order of 1552 was the work of Melanchthon's circle, and its examination was Melanchthon's *Examen ordinandorum*. The ordinand's promise names no book. He promises to remain in the doctrine he has just confessed in his examination. **Mecklenburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1552** (Sehling 5, p. 192):

After this admonition a Christian promise shall be taken of him: namely, that he will serve God in this holy office with the fear of God, with faith and calling upon God, and will live soberly and learn diligently. Item, that he will by God's help abide steadfastly in the pure Christian doctrine which he hath confessed in this hearing, and which by God's grace is preached with one accord in these churches, and will be faithful and diligent in the office. Whereupon the ordinand saith that by God's grace he will faithfully do and keep this.

Twenty years later the Rostock ministerium wrote a full list into its statutes. It includes the Mecklenburg church order, the Lüneburg Articles of 1561 against the Philippists, and the FC, "which they approved by their subscription in 1577". **Rostock, *Statuta et decreta*, 1573** (Sehling 5, p. 285):

I. That he embrace the sound and uncorrupt heavenly doctrine delivered in the writings of the prophets, apostles and evangelists, in that sense which is expressed in the creeds; in the confession exhibited at Augsburg to the emperor Charles V in the year 1530, and the apology thereof; in the Smalcald Articles; in the book of the ceremonial laws of this duchy, the Mecklenburg [book], as they call it; in the Large and Small Catechisms, and all the other writings of the divine Luther; in the Lüneburg Articles; and in the book of concord or agreement among those who teach in the churches and embrace the heavenly doctrine restored by Doctor Martin Luther, which in the year 1577 they approved by their subscription (but the laws were made in the year 73).

The editor's parenthesis shows that the FC was added to a statute of 1573. By Sehling's account, 444 Mecklenburg ministers signed the FC in 1577 (Sehling 5, pp. 142–143).

17.8.2 Kurland: the Wittenberg *Corpus doctrinae* (1570)

Kurland's church order of 1570 binds its new preachers to the CA and Apology, the creeds, the "oldest, unfalsified councils", the SA and "the whole Wittenberg *corpus doctrinae*" of 1560. **Kurland, *Kurländische Kirchenordnung*, 1570** (Sehling 5, p. 70):

When now the new preachers have been thus introduced and confirmed in the office of teaching, they shall endeavour to the utmost of their power to set before their congregation without fear, at Christ's command and according to the right doctrine thereof, the only saving word of God of the Biblical, that is, of the prophetic and apostolic Scripture, [and] the right understanding of the law and the gospel; according to the Augsburg Confession and Apology (whereof we doubt not, but have the certainty, that it is the right, only and true doctrine of the prophetic and apostolic testimony), the three creeds, the oldest unfalsified councils, the Smalcald Articles, and the whole Wittenberg *corpus doctrinae* (body of doctrine) made ready for the press by the late Master Philip Melanchthon in the year 1560, in the stead of a swan-song.

The Philippist corpus stands here beside the Smalcald Articles, a combination that the FC party would not allow after 1574.

17.8.3 Lauenburg: the FC as an alternative (1585)

Lauenburg's church order of 1585 makes each pastor promise to teach according to the creeds, the "ancient and unaltered" CA, the Apology, the SA, Luther's writings and catechisms, "or the *formula concordiae*, touching the points of doctrine in dispute". **Lauenburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1585** (Sehling 5, p. 402):

Secondly, that he shall teach and preach nothing but what God hath revealed in his holy written word of the Bible, according to the explanation of the three aforenamed creeds of the church, the ancient and unaltered Augsburg Confession, the Apology, the Smalcald Articles, the writings of Dr Martin Luther, and the Large and Small Catechism, or the *formula concordiae* (Formula of Concord) as touching the points of doctrine in dispute; and that he therefore diligently look through these books every day, turn them over, and make himself acquainted with them.

The FC is not a further book in a list. It is the authorised explanation of the older books where they are disputed.

17.8.4 Schleswig-Holstein (Gottorp): an oath instead of the Concord (1574, 1607)

The Danish king and the dukes in Schleswig-Holstein would not take the Torgau Book or the Bergen Book. By Sehling's account, the Gottorp theologians asked instead for a new edition of the *Corpus Philippicum*, with the SA and Luther's catechisms added (Sehling 23, p. 298). Instead of the Concord, Superintendent Paul von Eitzen drew up a preacher's oath against the Calvinists, centred on the Lord's Supper (Sehling 23, p. 309). **Schleswig-Holstein-Gottorp, *Predigereid*, 1574** (Sehling 23, p. 365; Low German):

even as this doctrine of the most worthy sacrament is declared in the Augsburg Confession, the Apology, the Smalcald Articles and both Catechisms of the holy teacher and father Martin Luther; which books, writings and confessions I also hold and believe in this article to be right and true. And by this my oath I bind myself, through the help and grace of God, faithfully to set forth and to teach the same true and simple doctrine of the holy Supper to the congregation committed to me, unfalsified and unaltered, until my end.

The same oath was used in the duke's pledged district of Peine, in the bishopric of Hildesheim (§17.10.1).

In 1607 Duke Johann Adolf abolished the oath and put a new one in its place. **Schleswig-Holstein-Gottorp, *Mitteilung über den Erlaß eines neuen Predigereides*, 4 January 1607** (Sehling 23, p. 415):

Forasmuch as we, for very weighty and moving causes, have caused the priest's oath hitherto held in use to be altered, as ye may perceive from the form enclosed, so that henceforth the ordinands shall swear the priestly oath after this new form of oath, and the former oath shall be cassated and abolished,

The new oath names no confession at all, only "the prophetic and apostolic Scriptures". **Schleswig-Holstein-Gottorp, *Neuer Predigereid*, 4 January 1607** (Sehling 23, p. 416):

I, N.N., swear to God that I will conduct the office of teaching committed to me with the highest faithfulness and due zeal, without carnal affections; [and] teach and preach the clear, pure word of God unfalsified, as the same is contained in the prophetic and apostolic Scriptures, without human, seductive additions and opinions;

The change from 1574 to 1607 is the plainest case in the corpus of a confessional oath being withdrawn. A Lutheran oath against the Calvinists gave way to a Scripture-only oath under a prince of Reformed sympathies.

17.9 Braunschweig-Wolfenbüttel, Lüneburg, Calenberg-Göttingen, Hoya and Goslar

Lower Saxony was the home ground of Chemnitz and Mörlin. It produced the most precise statements of the norm: the CA understood "as explained" by the Apology, the SA and Luther's catechism. It also produced the densest set of local corpora:

- the Lüneburg Articles of 1561;
- the Brunswick city corpus of 1571;
- the Lower Saxon Confession of 1571;
- the Wolfenbüttel *Corpus Julium* and the Lüneburg *Corpus Wilhelminum*, both of 1576.

Subscription to the corpus was the condition of admission in the cities as well as in the duchies.

17.9.1 Braunschweig-Wolfenbüttel: the CA "in the sense" of the Apology, the SA and the catechism (1569)

Duke Julius's church order of 1569 defines the *corpus doctrinae* (body of doctrine) and adds a "declaration" to shut out those who shelter under the name of the CA. **Braunschweig-Wolfenbüttel, *Kirchenordnung* of Duke Julius, 1569** (Sehling 6/1, pp. 91–92):

This then is the sum: that the *corpus doctrinae*, the form and pattern of pure doctrine, as the same shall henceforth be preached and taught in the churches of this principality, shall be the holy, prophetic and apostolic Scripture, in the simple, true, proper and sound sense, as Scripture expoundeth itself, and as the same sense is briefly drawn together out of and according to God's word in the ancient approved creeds, the Apostolic, the Nicene and the Athanasian, and in the articles of the Augsburg Confession. But forasmuch as, alas, in these last troubled times of the world certain factions and sects take upon them to cover and colour their corruptions under the name of the Augsburg Confession [...], this declaration must be plainly set thereby: that we accept, understand and hold the Augsburg Confession in the sense in which it hath been expounded and declared out of God's word in the Apology that followed and is annexed thereto, afterwards in the Smalcald Articles, and lastly in the catechism and other writings of Luther.

The editors' footnote at "the name of the Augsburg Confession" points to the *variata* of 1540. This formula, the CA read through the Apology, the SA and the catechism, was taken up almost word for word in Verden in 1606 (§17.10.2). It is also the rule by which the FC itself reads the CA.

17.9.2 Brunswick city: articles to be subscribed (1571)

The city of Brunswick's ministerium put to every new minister a set of Latin articles for subscription. They name the city's *corpus doctrinae* (body of doctrine) and condemn whatever the Lüneburg Articles condemn. **Brunswick, *Articuli, qui subscribendi proponuntur illis qui ad ministerium in hac ecclesia recipiuntur*, 1571** (Sehling 6/1, p. 471):

Articles which are set forth to be subscribed by those who are received into the ministry in this church. [...] [§ 1.] That he faithfully and constantly profess and retain with us the form of pure doctrine and of sound words, as it is set forth in the prophetic and apostolic writings and the approved creeds, and in the Augsburg Confession and the Apology thereof, as they were exhibited in the year 1530 and published in the year 1531, and as it is declared in the Smalcald Articles and Luther's catechisms. For this is the *corpus doctrinae* of this church. § 2. That he embrace not nor spread the corruptions that fight with this *corpus doctrinae*, whether they were condemned of old or have lately arisen or shall arise hereafter, but flee and condemn them; and especially those that are condemned in the Lüneburg Articles.

The city's order for calling preachers, of the same year, sets the subscription in the procedure. The new man subscribes and vows before he is admitted to the "colloquy", the city's assembly of ministers. **Brunswick, *Vokationsordnung für die Prediger*, 1571** (Sehling 6/1, p. 457):

Seventhly: when after all this the call hath been completed, the person accepted shall be presented to the colloquy by an honourable council and the treasurers of the ward, and there it shall be dealt with him that he subscribe the *corpus doctrinae* of this laudable church, and vow that he will submit himself to the well-established Christian order of the colloquy; and then shall he be received and accepted as a member of the colloquy.

By Sehling's account, the city council later sided against the duke over the signing of the FC (Sehling 6/1, p. 341).

17.9.3 Lüneburg: the duchy's confession (1564) and the city's corpus (1575)

The Lüneburg church order of 1564 states the duchy's doctrine as a confession of the prince, in its preface. It names the creeds, Luther's catechism, and the CA and Apology of 1530. **Principality of Lüneburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1564** (Sehling 6/1, p. 534):

but we confess that we hold for right the doctrine that is preached in our principality, which God himself hath revealed through his Son Jesus Christ, and which is contained in the writings of the prophets and apostles, in the sense that is set down and repeated in the creeds, the Apostolic, the Nicene and Athanasius's, and also in the catechism of Dr Martin Luther of blessed memory, and also in the confession and apology which were delivered to the Roman imperial majesty at Augsburg in the year 1530. And we purpose by God's help to abide steadfastly by such acknowledged doctrine.

The city of Lüneburg had its own corpus. Besides the usual books it held the confession of Lübeck, Hamburg and Lüneburg against the Interim of 1548. Each ordinand had to write his own confession, which was examined against it. **Lüneburg city, *Kirchenordnung der Stadt Lüneburg*, 1575** (Sehling 6/1, p. 654):

then he [the superintendent] commandeth them with all speed to set down in writing and deliver their confession of the chiefest and most necessary articles of the church's doctrine, which [must] agree throughout with the writings of the holy prophets, of Christ and of the apostles; with the three creeds, the Apostolic, the Nicene and Athanasius's; with the confession which was

delivered in the year 30 by certain estates of the holy Roman Empire to the Roman imperial majesty Charles V at the diet at Augsburg, together with the Apology that was set forth shortly after; with the Smalcald Articles, Luther's catechisms, and the confession of these three honourable cities, Lübeck, Hamburg and Lüneburg, which came forth in print in the year 1548 against the Interim; which writings are held for the corpus or foundation of the doctrine of this church.

In 1576 the duchy received Chemnitz's *Corpus doctrinae Wilhelminum*. By Sehling's account it was still signed with the church order of 1643 (Sehling 6/1, pp. 487–489).

17.9.4 Calenberg-Göttingen: the *Corpus Julium* (1601) and Göttingen's own order (1568)

When the Wolfenbüttel dukes inherited Calenberg-Göttingen, its four great towns came under their corpus. A preacher presented for a town where the duke was patron had to subscribe the ducal church order and the *Corpus doctrinae Julium*, and then the town's own church order. **Calenberg-Göttingen, *Gandersheimer Landtagsabschied*, 1601** (Sehling 6/2, p. 894):

and when the person presented hath been found sufficiently qualified in doctrine and life, and hath subscribed the princely church order and the *Corpus doctrinae Julium*, the same person shall be sent over to the council and ministry there for the trial sermon, and, if the call be not refused for weighty causes, at the same time for induction and for subscription of their particular church order set up many years ago.

Göttingen's own order had made the norm in 1568. It runs: the CA of 1530, the Apology, the SA, Luther's catechism and "our old church order of the city of Göttingen, reviewed and approved by Luther". **Göttingen, *Christliche und in Gottes wort … gegründte kirchenordnung der stadt Göttingen*, 1568** (Sehling 6/2, p. 916):

that, as was done here in the year 30 at the receiving of the gospel through God's gracious visitation, so henceforth also [they] purpose to abide with one accord and in simplicity by the right Augsburg Confession, as the same was delivered in the year 30 by the protesting estates to the Roman imperial majesty, and by the Apology thereof, the Smalcald Articles, Luther's catechism, and our old church order of the city of Göttingen, reviewed and approved by Luther, as the same are grounded thoroughly on the writings of the prophets and apostles and further explained in Luther's books; and that all that is contrary to the same, be its name what it will, and come it from whom it will, shall be rejected.

17.9.5 Hoya: the FC in the church order (1581)

The county of Hoya's church order of 1581 sets the FC at the end of the list. It calls Luther's catechisms "the laymen's Bible". **Hoya, *Kirchenordnung*, 1581** (Sehling 6/2, p. 1131):

that in all their sermons and teachings they shall behave themselves throughout conformably and with one accord according to the prophetic and apostolic writings of the Old and New Testaments; the three universal chief creeds, namely the Apostolic, the Nicene and the Athanasian; the pure, unaltered Augsburg Confession, which was delivered to the emperor Charles V at Augsburg in the year 30 in the great diet of the empire, together with the Apology thereof, and the Articles set forth at Smalcald in the year 37 and subscribed at that time by the chief theologians; the catechisms, Large and Small, of Master Dr Martin Luther, as the laymen's Bible, wherein is briefly comprehended all that is handled at large in holy Scripture, and is needful for a godly, devout Christian to know for his salvation; and also the *formula concordiae* (Formula of Concord), that is, the Christian, repeated, unanimous confession of the electors, princes and estates of the Augsburg Confession, completed and published in the year 80.

The order goes on to threaten anyone found not to hold by "these writings, as the right rule … the only touchstone".

17.9.6 Goslar: a city corpus signed "with our own hands" (1591/95)

The imperial city of Goslar adopted its corpus on 9 November 1591 and signed the list in 1595. The list is notable for three things:

- it names the Apology "as it first came forth in print";
- it includes the Lower Saxon Confession of 1571 "in its right Saxon sense";
- it holds the FC "in its right Saxon sense" as signed by the council and ministry in 1577.

No minister or schoolmaster is to be admitted unless he has signed. **Goslar, *Verzeichnis der in Goslar gültigen Lehrschriften*, 11 May 1595** (Sehling 7/2.2, pp. 339–340):

We, the whole ministry of the church and congregation of God of the imperial free city of Goslar, do make known and confess with this our own subscription that in the year after the blessed birth of Christ our Lord 1591, on the 9th day of November, in the presence of our Christian magistrates […], we accepted and received these books, writings and confessions following for a *corpus doctrinae* (body of doctrine), […] Fifthly, we confess ourselves also to the Apology of the same Augsburg Confession, as it came forth in print the first time. […] Seventhly, we confess ourselves also to the Confession of the Saxon Churches in its right Saxon sense, as it was given to the press in the year of Christ 1571 with one accord, with the subscription and signature of the Saxon churches. […] Eighthly, we hold ourselves also steadfastly and firmly to the *Formula concordiae* of our evangelical churches in its right Saxon sense, as it hath been received and accepted, and also subscribed with one accord, and especially also by an honourable council and ministry here at Goslar in the year of Christ 1577. […] Neither shall anyone in time to come be received and accepted as a minister of the church or schoolmaster, or be suffered therein, unless he, as well as we, have subscribed this our *corpus doctrinae* now named with his own hand, […] For the greater witness of the truth we have subscribed with our own hands.

"*hemden*" ("shirts") is the OCR's reading of *henden*, "hands".

17.10 Hildesheim, Verden, Osnabrück, Oldenburg, Bremen, East Frisia and Soest

The north-west was confessionally divided. The Lutheran cities and counties (Hildesheim, Verden, Osnabrück, Oldenburg, Soest) held to the FC, or reached it late. Bremen went over to the Philippist and then the Reformed side. East Frisia settled its quarrel in 1599 by naming nothing but "the Augsburg Confession".

17.10.1 Hildesheim: the Peine oath (1574/89) and the subscription of the city's officials (1593)

The ducal oath used in Gottorp (§17.8.4) was also used in Peine, a district of the bishopric of Hildesheim held in pledge by the dukes of Schleswig-Holstein. It is printed here in High German, sworn "by the holy name of God". The first two articles bind to Scripture and the creeds and are aimed at the Calvinist Christology. **Peine, *Eid und obligation der prediger im herzogtumb Schleswiegk wie auch in ihren fürstl. gn. pfandgericht und ampt Peina*, [1574/89]** (Sehling 7/2.1, p. 787):

1. I, N., preacher of the holy gospel, orderly called and summoned by the will of God, swear by the holy name of God and of my Redeemer Jesus Christ that I hold and believe the divine, Biblical Scripture to be true in all points, articles and words. 2. Secondly, that I also hold and believe the holy Apostolic Creed and the other true creeds, which have been approved and received by the holy universal Christian church, to be true in all articles of our Christian faith according to the rule of God's word; and so also in the article of the inseparable union of the two natures, divine and human, in the one undivided person of Christ, which inseparable union no time nor hour can dissolve or divide in eternity.

Its third and fourth articles go on to the CA with the Apology, the SA and the catechisms, and to the Lord's Supper "as declared in the Augsburg Confession, Apology, Smalcald Articles and both Catechisms" (Sehling 7/2.1, p. 788).

The city of Hildesheim had signed the FC on 10 April 1580 (Sehling's apparatus, Sehling 7/2.1, p. 909). In 1593 its government extended the subscription to the city's lay officials. The council's decision is known only from Sehling's introduction, which quotes it from the council's records. **Hildesheim, council decision on the subscription of the *Formula Concordiae*, 30 August 1593, quoted in Sehling's introduction** (Sehling 7/2.1, p. 817):

Whereas on the 18th of June last past the laudable joint government of the city of Hildesheim took counsel with one accord that the lord superintendent, the lords burgomasters, the syndics, the physicians, the secretaries, and also all preachers and schoolmasters of both towns should confirm the *Formula Concordiae* and the Apology thereof with their subscription; therefore the said resolution hath been renewed and once more concluded by the laudable government: that by them and their successors, every one without any reservation, even as the lord superintendent hath made the beginning, shall confess himself to the said *Formula Concordiae* and the Apology thereof with his own hand, and subscribe the same. Done the 30th of August in the year, etc., 93.

The "Apology" is the Erfurt Apology of the BoC (1582). Sehling adds that the last signature under the Hildesheim Concord dates from 1824. The city's school order binds every teacher in the same way. **Hildesheim, *Schulordnung*, 1574/1618** (Sehling 7/2.1, p. 909):

And forasmuch as to that end the *Formula Concordiae*, together with the Apology thereof, hath been received among us, all our colleagues shall not only be tied and bound to the subscription of such books,

17.10.2 Verden: the CA "in the sense" of the Apology, the SA and the catechisms (1606)

The Verden church order of 1606 takes over the Wolfenbüttel "declaration" of 1569 (§17.9.1) almost word for word. **Bishopric of Verden, *Kirchenordnung*, 1606** (Sehling 7/1, p. 149):

then shall and must the declaration be observed therewith: that we accept and hold the Augsburg Confession and the doctrine and content thereof in the sense in which it hath been expounded and explained in the Apology that followed thereon, and further in the Smalcald Articles, and lastly in the Large and Small Catechism of Luther, and the other books and writings of this dear and worthy man of God.

17.10.3 Osnabrück: the Wittenberg Concord and the Book of Concord (1610)

The city of Osnabrück's ordinance for its superintendent and preachers names, between the Apology and the SA, "the *Formula Concordiae* set up in the year 1536", that is, the Wittenberg Concord on the Supper. It ends with the Book of Concord. **Osnabrück, *Superintendenten- und Predigerordnung*, 1610** (Sehling 7/1, pp. 296–297):

That namely and first of all they conduct pure and sound doctrine in their parish churches according to the *corpus doctrinae* (body of doctrine) of the old, unaltered Augsburg Confession, as it was delivered at the diet at Augsburg in the year fifteen hundred and thirty to the Roman imperial majesty Charles the Fifth, of most blessed memory, whereunto we and our congregation confess ourselves; in the sense in which it hath been expounded and explained in the Apology that followed thereon, item [in] the *Formula Concordiae* set up in the year 1536, as also in the Smalcald Articles and in Luther's Large and Small Catechism, and also in the Book of Concord, or the Christian repeated unanimous confession of the secular electors, princes and cities.

The confession here is made by the council ("we and our congregation"). The duty is laid on the preachers.

17.10.4 Oldenburg: the *Corpus Philippicum* (1573), then the FC (1586–1609)

Oldenburg's church order of 1573 adds to the Lutheran confessions the books "inserted and incorporated" in Melanchthon's *Corpus doctrinae* (body of doctrine). **Oldenburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1573** (Sehling 7/2.1, pp. 987–988):

The whole Christian doctrine is and is called law and gospel, set down in the Biblical, prophetic and apostolic writings which we call the Old and New Testament, whereof the short sum and compass standeth in the three creeds, the Apostolic, the Nicene and the Athanasian; and in the articles of the Augsburg Confession and the Apology thereof, the Smalcald Articles, Luther's catechism, and the books following thereon and annexed, which are inserted and incorporated in the *Corpus doctrinae* written by Master Philip of blessed memory, such as are the repetition of the Augsburg Confession, the *Loci communes*, the Examination of the Ordinands, and the refutation of the papistical Bavarian articles. This doctrine and these books shall the pastors themselves know and have, and according to them set forth the Christian doctrine to the people understandably, orderly and unfalsified.

The FC came in by way of the *Bestallungen*, the letters of appointment. Sehling's apparatus quotes them:

- 1574 (Hamelmann): Scripture, the CA, the catechism and the church order.
- 1586 (Johannes Judex): adds the FC.
- 1608 (Superintendent Gottfried Schlüter): the full later norm, with a clause against the Calvinists. **Oldenburg, *Bestallung* of Superintendent Gottfried Schlüter, 1608, quoted in Sehling's apparatus** (Sehling 7/2.1, p. 964):

[that he shall] teach God's holy saving word purely and clearly, without any corruptions, according to the Biblical writings of the Old and New Testaments, the Augsburg Confession grounded thereon, unfalsified, delivered in the year 1530 at the great diet at Augsburg to the emperor Charles the Fifth and incorporated in the *Formula Concordiae*, the Smalcald Articles that followed thereon, Luther's Large and Small Catechism, the *Formula Concordiae*, and our church order,

The phrase "the CA … incorporated in the FC" identifies the *invariata* (unaltered) by the text printed in the BoC. The visitation articles of 1609 ask each pastor to confess the FC and the church order and to "condemn the Calvinist doctrine of election, of the person of the Lord Christ and of the most worthy sacraments" (Sehling 7/2.1, p. 1175).

17.10.5 Bremen: the *Corpus Philippicum* and the road to the Reformed (1570–1575)

The Bremen texts of these years are Philippist orders; the city's Reformed orders begin in 1582.

Bremen's ministerium (Philippist) agreed in 1572 on a "simple confession", by which all future ministers were to be bound. It names Scripture, the creeds, the CA and the *Corpus doctrinae* (body of doctrine) of Melanchthon, "which the Electoral Saxon and other churches have received". **Bremen, *Einigung des geistlichen Ministeriums über die in Bremen gültige Lehre*, 1572** (Philippist; Sehling 7/2.2, p. 548):

we have agreed upon the following simple confession (whereby all ministers of the church who are yet to be received hereafter should also have to govern themselves, for the causes now mentioned): namely, that above all things we have confessed and do still confess ourselves to the holy Scripture, and after it to the Christian creeds, the *Augustana confessio*, and the *Corpus doctrinae christianae* of Philip Melanchthon (which the Electoral Saxon and other churches have received, and appeal thereto in its right sense according to God's word). Yea, that we also [hold] to the Verden recess, so far as the same, together with the *Corpus doctrinae*, agreeth rightly and conformably with God's word […]

The call of Markus Mening in 1570 adds the Apology and the *Confessio Saxonica* (Saxon Confession) (Sehling 7/2.2, p. 544). The settlement of 1575 adds the Frankfurt Recess of 1558 (p. 566). None of these Bremen texts names the SA. This is the Philippist canon, and from it the city went over to the Reformed confession.

17.10.6 East Frisia: "the Augsburg Confession" and nothing more (1593, 1599)

In East Frisia, Lutheran and Reformed congregations lived side by side. Count Edzard II's church order for Marienhafe (1593) is fully Lutheran. It names the "unfalsified" CA and Apology, the catechisms "as the laymen's Bible" and the FC of 1580, in words close to Hoya's (§17.9.5). **East Frisia, *Marienhafer Kirchenordnung*, 1593** (Sehling 7/1, p. 684):

so we will that it be earnestly laid upon and commanded hereby to all our pastors, preachers and ministers of the church, that in all their sermons, religious dealings and conversations they behave themselves throughout conformably and with one accord according to the prophetic and apostolic writings set down in the holy Bible, together with the three creeds, the Apostolic, the Nicene and Athanasius's; the unfalsified Augsburg Confession and the Apology thereof; Luther's catechisms, Large and Small (as the laymen's Bible); and the *Formula Concordiae*, repeated, completed and published in the year 1580, etc.

The treaty between the count and the estates in 1599, a Reformed–Lutheran treaty, named only the CA. The editors' footnote at this point discusses the *variata*. The treaty goes on to admit that, from the beginning of the Reformation, both "opinions" about the CA's sense had been preached and suffered in the land (Sehling 7/1, p. 422). **East Frisia, *Die Konkordaten*, 1599** (Reformed–Lutheran treaty; Sehling 7/1, p. 421):

that in our land, churches and schools no other doctrine shall be publicly set before the people, defended or maintained, than that which, agreeably to the prophetic and apostolic writings, is gathered together and set down in the Christian confession of the Augsburg Confession.

17.10.7 Soest: "our *corpus doctrinae*", subscribed before admission (1590)

The preachers of Soest agreed on articles in 1590, "without whose subscription no one shall henceforth be admitted into our ministry". The first article lists the corpus on which they had themselves been examined and ordained. **Soest, *Artikel der Prediger*, 1 September 1590** (Sehling 22, p. 480):

without the subscription of which articles no one shall henceforth be admitted into our ministry; and the articles are these following: 1. Our *corpus doctrinae* (body of doctrine) is and shall be the holy Bible, the prophetic and apostolic Scripture; the three approved creeds, namely the Apostolic, the Nicene and Athanasius's; the Augsburg Confession and the Apology thereof, as the same was delivered in the year fifteen hundred and thirty to the Roman imperial majesty; the Smalcald Articles; the Small and Large Catechism of Luther; and the *Formula Concordiae*: upon which *corpus doctrinae* we have been examined and ordained and have entered into the holy preaching office, and whereby we will also abide steadfastly unto our graves, by means of God's help.

Soest was biconfessional in other respects. In 1583 it admitted godparents of both religions (§17.17.4).

17.11 Hesse, Waldeck, Frankfurt, Nassau and Ysenburg

By the editors' account the Hessian landgraves (Philippist) together rejected the FC (Sehling 8, p. 344; Sehling 9, p. 33), although the introduction to Hessen-Darmstadt speaks of Darmstadt's signature in 1577 (Sehling 9, p. 45). After Philip's death (1567) its general synods held to the CA, the Apology, the SA, Luther's catechism and the Wittenberg *Corpus doctrinae* (body of doctrine). The Agende of 1574 called the CA "the symbol of this our time". Once the landgraviate was divided, the two halves went separate ways. Hessen-Kassel bound its pastors by oath against the ubiquity doctrine (1598) and turned Reformed. Hessen-Darmstadt made every minister, professor and schoolmaster swear to the unaltered CA and renounce the Calvinists (1617). The neighbouring counties show the same spread:

- **Waldeck** took the FC into its ordination question.
- **Frankfurt** took the Book of Concord into its ordination question.
- **Nassau** went from Melanchthon's *Loci* (Commonplaces) to an explicitly Reformed order (Dillenburg 1582).
- **Nassau-Weilburg and Ysenburg** held to the unaltered CA.

17.11.1 Hesse: the synod, the Agende, and the divided landgraviate (1571–1617)

The general synod's *Abschied* (recess) of 1571 (Philippist) records the pastors' undertaking to teach according to a mixed norm: the SA beside the Wittenberg *Corpus doctrinae* (body of doctrine). **Hesse, *Abschied* of the general synod, 1571** (Philippist; Sehling 8, p. 355):

[they declared themselves] ready and willing from the heart not only themselves to teach according to the holy divine Scripture and the three creeds grounded therein, the Augsburg Confession, the Apology following thereon, the Smalcald Articles, Luther's catechism and the *corpus doctrinae* (body of doctrine) that came forth at Wittenberg, but also to labour with the utmost diligence that the like be done by others, both in schools and in churches.

The Agende of 1574 (Philippist) puts Scripture alone as the *norma iudicii*, with the creeds and the CA as "the symbol of this our time". One witness of the text (B) adds the Apology and the *Corpus doctrinae* of "P. M." (Philip Melanchthon). **Hesse, *Agende*, 1574** (Philippist; Sehling 8, p. 415):

then in all and every point of Christian doctrine the prophetic and apostolic writings shall be the right foundation, the only *norma iudicii*, rule and line, according to which all controversies and errors arising may be decided and laid aside; and next to the holy divine Scripture the three approved creeds, the Apostolic, the Nicene and the Athanasian, and likewise the Augsburg Confession, the symbol of this our time, as being truly founded and grounded in the prophetic and apostolic writings and sufficient for proper and needful instruction concerning every article.

After the division, the pastors of the Lower County of Katzenelnbogen, under Hessen-Kassel (still Philippist in 1598), swore a service oath with a long Christological section. It names the four councils and Leo's Tome alongside the CA, the Apology, the SA and the Hessian synodal *Abschiede*, and it rejects the "newly introduced bodily ubiquity". **Hessen-Kassel, *Diensteid der Pfarrer in der Niedergrafschaft Katzenelnbogen*, 20 February 1598** (Philippist; Sehling 9, p. 54):

But in especial we confess ourselves with mouth and heart to the pure doctrine of the person of our Lord Jesus Christ, and namely, as touching the newly introduced bodily ubiquity and omnipresence, to the plain word of God, understood not stupidly but rightly; to the three chief creeds, the Apostolic, the Nicene and the Athanasian; likewise to the four chief councils approved in the church of God, and especially to the council of Chalcedon and the epistle of Leo to Flavian; as also to the Augsburg Confession, the Apology thereof, and […] the Smalcald Articles, and the synodal recesses that followed thereon, etc.; and will by virtue of the same abide also by the customary forms of speech

The oath goes on to reject, as "monstrous and portentous propositions", the teaching that Christ's humanity is "almighty, all-knowing, infinite and everywhere present".

Hessen-Darmstadt, which stayed Lutheran, answered with a mandate that made the unaltered CA a sworn condition of office. It also required a negative declaration against every other confession. **Hessen-Darmstadt, *Mandat zur Beibehaltung der Confessio Augustana*, 28 July 1617** (Sehling 9, p. 152):

Wherefore also no theologian, professor, preacher or schoolmaster shall be received in churches and schools, except he first vow and swear that he will teach nothing else than what is agreeable to God's word and the aforesaid true, unaltered Augsburg Confession; and especially also declare himself with mouth and heart, *in affirmativa et negativa* (in the affirmative and the

negative), that he is right and pure in confession, and not catholic or papist, Zwinglian or Calvinist, Anabaptist, nor related or addicted to other erroneous and contrary sects.

17.11.2 Waldeck: the FC in the ordination vow

Waldeck's ordination form, in a manuscript revision of the church order of 1556 that the editors date to about 1584 and record in their apparatus (Sehling 9, p. 173), copies Henneberg's question of 1582 (§17.6.2). The editors gloss the "formula of union" as the FC of 1577. **Waldeck, *Kirchenordnung* 1556, ordination form in the revision of about 1584** (Sehling 9, p. 292):

Secondly we ask whether ye will also direct your faith and confession according to God's word, as the same is contained in the prophetic and apostolic holy Scripture, and likewise according to the three chief creeds, and the true, well-grounded Augsburg Confession taken therefrom, the Apology, the Smalcald Articles, Luther's Small and Large Catechism, together with the present Christian formula of union [= the Formula of Concord of 1577]? Then promise it hereby to God and his holy Christian church, and to us.

17.11.3 Frankfurt: the Book of Concord in the ordination vow (1589)

The imperial city of Frankfurt put the Book of Concord into the questions of its ordination rite. The ordinand answers "Yea". **Frankfurt, *Agende*, 1589** (Sehling 9, p. 541):

But will ye also, with God's help and grace, abide faithfully and diligently by the clear, bright and express word of God, which is contained in the writings of Moses, of the prophets and of the apostles, and hath lately been repeated and declared in the Augsburg Confession, the Smalcald Articles, both Catechisms of Luther and the Christian Book of Concord; and also faithfully follow all the Christian ordinances of this church of Frankfurt? Answer: Yea.

The confessions are presented as a recent *repetition* of Scripture, not as a separate norm.

17.11.4 Nassau: from Melanchthon's *Loci* to the Reformed confession (1564–1582)

The Nassau-Diez *Revers* (pledge) of 1564 names the creeds, the CA and "Philip's *Loci*". It is a promise ("vow and promise"), not an oath. **Nassau-Diez, *Revers der Kirchendiener*, [1564]** (Sehling 10, p. 103):

Points which those who are received into the preaching office in the churches of the well-born, our gracious lord, etc., must vow and promise according to the ordinance: 1. That they will set forth the holy doctrine purely and clearly according to the writings of the holy prophets and apostles, in the sense expressed in the creeds, the Apostolic, the Nicene and Athanasius's, and also in the Augsburg Confession and Philip's *Loci* (Commonplaces); and will sow no new dogmas, nor use their own and peculiar forms of speech whereby disunity and division might arise among ourselves, or offence among the people.

By 1582 Nassau-Dillenburg had adopted the Reformed confession (Reformed). Its church order of that year required, before the Supper, a confession of "the Reformed doctrine" (§17.17.2).

17.11.5 Nassau-Weilburg and Ysenburg: the unaltered CA (1576, 1588)

Nassau-Weilburg's visitors asked each pastor whether he taught the chief articles "as they are briefly set down in the unaltered Augsburg Confession". **Nassau-Weilburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1574/1576** (Sehling 10, p. 306):

Articles upon which the pastors and ministers of the church are to be asked: 1. Whether he set forth diligently and faithfully to the congregation committed to him the chief articles of our Christian religion according to the prophetic and apostolic writings, as they are briefly set down in the unaltered Augsburg Confession which was delivered in the year [15]30 to the emperor Charles, the Fifth of that name, and repeated in other approved symbols of the pure evangelical churches (which are addicted and related to the unaltered Augsburg Confession).

The Agende of 1618 adds the Apology, the SA and the catechisms (Sehling 10, p. 233). In 1609 the same territory told its pastors to admit, with discretion, godparents who did not hold the unaltered CA in every point (§17.17.4).

The county of Ysenburg-Birstein gave its pastors a *norma doctrinae* of the creeds, the unaltered CA, the Apology, the SA and both catechisms. **Ysenburg-Birstein, *Kirchenordnung*, 1588** (Sehling 10, p. 619):

First, the pastors and ministers of the church shall have a certain *norma doctrinae*, whereby they may govern themselves in knowing and distinguishing right and false doctrine. They shall also teach nothing else than what is agreeable to the Scripture of the prophets and apostles, the approved creeds, and the unaltered Augsburg Confession delivered in the year 1530, together with the Apology thereof, as also to the Smalcald Articles and both Catechisms of Luther.

The FC is not named. The order goes on to tell pastors to read Luther and Philip.

17.12 The Palatinates: Kurpfalz, the Upper Palatinate, Pfalz-Neuburg, Pfalz-Zweibrücken and Sponheim

The Wittelsbach Palatinates show more clearly than anywhere else how a single binding formula could carry different confessions in turn. The Kurpfalz *Kirchendienerbestallung* kept its wording through four reigns while its content changed:

Reign	Confessional content
Ottheinrich (1556)	Lutheran: CA, Apol, SA and Luther's catechism
Ludwig VI (1580)	Lutheran: the Book of Concord
Johann Casimir (1586)	Reformed: the Heidelberg Catechism, with the CA and Apol "in their right sense"
Friedrich IV (1601)	Reformed: bound "with fealty given by the hand in the stead of a bodily sworn oath"

The Upper Palatinate, which had signed the FC in 1581–82, was released from it in 1585 under the Reformed regent. Pfalz-Neuburg stayed Lutheran and signed. Pfalz-Zweibrücken, then Lutheran, drew up its own Latin subscription in 1564, which Strasbourg also used. The Hintere Grafschaft Sponheim took the FC as "the symbol" of the Lutheran churches in 1608.

17.12.1 Kurpfalz: one formula, four confessions (1556–1601)

Ottheinrich's church order of 1556 binds pastors to the creeds, the CA and Apology of 1530 "in their right, unfalsified sense", the SA and Luther's catechism. **Kurpfalz, *Kirchenordnung* of Ottheinrich, 1556** (Sehling 14, pp. 114–115):

that ye abide by the rule of God's word in your doctrine, preaching and whole church office, and turn not aside therefrom to the right hand nor to the left […]; and that in your teaching, preaching and conferring, etc., ye behave yourselves agreeably to the old approved creeds, the Apostolic, the Nicene and the Athanasian, and to the Augsburg Confession and the Apology thereof (as the same was delivered by the Christian electors and estates to the emperor Charles the Fifth in the year 1530, in its right, unfalsified sense, whereunto we have at all times appealed and do still appeal with mouth and heart, and purpose by the grant of divine grace to abide steadfastly thereby to our end), and likewise to the Smalcald Articles and Luther's catechism as it is incorporated in this our church order; and mingle or bring in nothing unlike or contrary.

Under Ludwig VI (1576–1583), who restored Lutheranism after his father's Reformed reign, the formula was extended to the Book of Concord. **Kurpfalz, *Kirchendienerbestallung*, 1580** (Sehling 14, p. 507):

And forasmuch as the points of religion in controversy against the papacy and the sects are declared in the Augsburg Confession and the Apology thereof according to the right understanding of the prophetic and apostolic writings, ye shall and will abide by the said Confession and Apology, and likewise by the Book of Concord approved by the Electoral Palatinate and also by certain other electors, princes, counts, lords and estates of the empire, [and] their churches and schools; and shall neither bring in nor defend any old or new opinion or sect contrary thereto.

Six years later, under the Reformed administrator Johann Casimir, the same sentence returns without the Book of Concord. The catechism that "directs" the pastor to the CA is now the large and small Heidelberg Catechism, as the editors note. **Kurpfalz, *Kirchendienerbestallung*, 1586** (Reformed; Sehling 14, p. 525):

And forasmuch as the points of religion in controversy against the papacy and the sects are declared in the Augsburg Confession and the Apology thereof according to the right understanding of the prophetic and apostolic writings, ye shall and will abide finally by the said Confession and Apology, in such measure as the Large and Small Catechism, newly revised and incorporated in the church order, directeth you thereto.

The 1586 text is thus a Reformed subscription to the CA, read through the Heidelberg Catechism. By 1601 the schoolmasters' *Bestallung* (appointment) was written in the first person. It ends with a pledge "with fealty given by the hand in the stead of a

bodily sworn oath", confirmed by the man's own signature. **Kurpfalz, *Schuldienerbestallung*, 1601** (Reformed; Sehling 14, p. 593):

All this to hold steadfast, firm and inviolable, and also to perform all else that becometh and well beseemeth a faithful schoolmaster and obedient subject, I do hereby vow with fealty given by the hand in the stead of a bodily sworn oath, and do oblige and bind myself thereto with my own signature, faithfully and without guile.

The same handfast pledge "in the stead of an oath" appears in Pfalz-Neuburg's *Bestallung* of 1555 (Sehling 13, p. 108).

17.12.2 The Upper Palatinate: released from the Book of Concord (1585)

The instruction of 1585 is a Reformed order.

The Upper Palatinate's clergy signed the FC in 1581–82 (Sehling's introduction, Sehling 13, p. 269). When Johann Casimir took over the regency, his instruction to the church council of 1585 defined the CA by its later repetitions at Frankfurt (1557/58) and Naumburg (1561). The editors' footnote calls this "entirely in the sense of the so-called *Variata*". The instruction then released the ministers from their obligation to the BoC. **Upper Palatinate, *Kirchenratsinstruktion*, 3 March 1585** (Reformed; Sehling 13, pp. 328–329):

then [according to] the confession delivered to the emperor Charles at the diet at Augsburg in the year [15]30, and the apology annexed, in the right and sound sense, as it was then meant by the Christian electors and princes, and afterwards at sundry assemblies (as in the years [15]57 and [15]58 at Frankfurt, and [15]61 at Naumburg) repeated, rehearsed and declared by the electors and estates of the aforesaid Augsburg Confession, and also set forth and defended by their theologians, […] Forasmuch as we ought to look to God's word alone as the indivisible rule, and bind ourselves to no writings or authority of men, we command and will that all ministers of church and school in our aforesaid principality in Bavaria be wholly released from the duty they took upon them to the Book of Concord, and henceforth be bound and taken into duty to God's word alone and to the [norm] set down above.

The phrase "to bind ourselves to no writings of men" is the Reformed answer to subscription as such.

17.12.3 Pfalz-Neuburg: the Wittenberg Concord against the Calvinists (1564), the *corpus doctrinae* (1576)

Duke Wolfgang's mandate of 1564 against the Calvinists prescribed the "phrases and ways of speaking" for the Supper. They were to be taken from the CA, the Apology, the Wittenberg Concord of 1536, the SA and the church order. **Pfalz-Neuburg, *Mandat gegen die Kalvinisten*, 1564** (Sehling 13, p. 148):

we will and command hereby earnestly that all our ministers of the church henceforth, in their sermons and also in private instructions, especially when they are to explain the matter of the Lord's Supper, bring in no new, unwonted phrases and ways of speaking, but use most of all the phrases and ways of speaking that are set and contained in God's word, the Augsburg Confession, the Apology thereof and the *concordia de caena Domini* (concord concerning the Lord's Supper) set up at Wittenberg in the year [15]36, and also in the Smalcald Articles and our church order.

By 1576 these books were called the territory's *corpus doctrinae* (body of doctrine), with the CA as "the symbol of the right, true church of our time". **Pfalz-Neuburg, *Generalartikel*, 1576** (Sehling 13, p. 171):

that the same [exposition of Scripture] be conducted first of all agreeably to holy Scripture itself, and then also not contrary to the three creeds, the Apostolic, the Nicene and Athanasius's, nor likewise to the Augsburg Confession as it was delivered in the year 1530 to the emperor Charles the Fifth, as the symbol of the right, true church of our time, [nor] to the Apology thereof, the Smalcald Articles and Luther's catechism, but in every way agreeably [to them] as to the pure *corpus doctrinae*; and that if anyone teach contrary thereto and persist in the erroneous opinion he hath conceived, he shall in no wise be suffered in the principality.

Pfalz-Neuburg later signed the BoC (Sehling's introduction, Sehling 13, p. 35).

17.12.4 Pfalz-Zweibrücken: "I subscribe with mind and hand" (1564)

Pfalz-Zweibrücken's Latin *Bekenntnisverpflichtung* of 1564 is the most elaborate personal subscription in the corpus. It is written in the first person and goes article by article:

- Scripture;
- *four* creeds: the Apostles', the Nicene, the Athanasian, and the Te Deum "thought to have been made by Augustine and Ambrose";
- the four councils;
- the CA of 1530, as understood by those who presented it;
- the history of its later editions;
- the SA, each with its own act of assent.

Strasbourg used the same text in 1565, and Sickingen in 1564. **Pfalz-Zweibrücken, *Bekenntnisverpflichtung der Kirchendiener*, 1564** (Sehling 18, pp. 328–329):

1. Therefore I embrace from my heart all the writings of the prophets and apostles of the Old and New Testaments, which are the very certain and undoubted word of God [...] 2. Then I believe, embrace and confess those four creeds of the catholic church: the Apostolic, the Nicene, the Athanasian, and that which is thought to have been made by Augustine and Ambrose. [...] 4. [...] with my whole heart I embrace and receive that form and sum of the doctrine of religion which was exhibited in writing by the most illustrious Elector of Saxony and other princes, and the two cities of Nürnberg and Reutlingen, to the emperor Charles V at Augsburg in the year 1530, which is thence named the Augsburg Confession. [...] I therefore assent from my heart to these Smalcald Articles, which I acknowledge and confess to be true and conformable to the holy Scriptures (for they have the certain and undoubted testimonies of the prophetic and apostolic books), as they are set down according to the letter; and without any sophistry I subscribe them with mind and hand.

"*κατα το ρητον*", "according to the letter", excludes any reservation. Pfalz-Zweibrücken did not go on to the FC. By Sehling's account, Duke Johann announced the official rejection of the Book of Concord in 1580 (Sehling 18, p. 40).

17.12.5 Sponheim: the FC as "the symbol of all pure churches" (1608)

The Hintere Grafschaft Sponheim, a condominium of Baden and the Palatine house, had made the CA, Melanchthon's *Loci* (Commonplaces) and his *Examen* (examination) its *corpus doctrinae* (body of doctrine) in 1560 (Sehling 18, p. 636). In 1608 the visitors complained that some pastors had neither bought nor read the FC. **Hintere Grafschaft Sponheim, *Generalartikel*, 1608** (Sehling 18, p. 671):

Certain pastors in the Hinder County of Sponheim have not only not bought the *formula concordiae* (Formula of Concord) for their libraries, but also in part have not read it; which is nevertheless now held *pro symbolo* (as a creed) of all pure churches of the unfalsified Augsburg Confession; and it was also the express will of the late Lord Charles, Count Palatine, of Christian and gentle memory, that both his princely grace's children and the subjects of the land should be directed thereto.

The article goes on to require every pastor to buy the octavo edition within a year and to declare in writing to both chancelleries whether he assented to all its articles (Sehling 18, pp. 671–672).

17.13 Württemberg, Hohenlohe and the Swabian cities

Württemberg had its own confession, the *Confessio Virtembergica*, which Brenz drew up for the Council of Trent in 1552. From the 1550s it set that confession beside the CA. Its theologians, Andreae above all, were the authors of the Concord, and in 1577 the duke ordered every minister to sign the FC. Hohenlohe, Württemberg's neighbour, shows a different path. In 1578 it made its own *corpus doctrinae* (body of doctrine). In 1581, on Andreae's advice, it cut that corpus down to the CA. From 1603 it bound its ministers to a local *Gründlicher Bericht* (Thorough report) in place of the FC. The free cities of Swabia (Hall, Wimpfen, Ravensburg, Ulm) mostly signed. Some had their own local formula as well.

17.13.1 Württemberg: the CA and the *Loci* (1547), the CA and "our Confession" (after 1559)

Duke Ulrich's visitation order of 1547 directs preaching to the CA and Apology, and sends the ordinary preachers to Melanchthon's later *Loci* (Commonplaces), "for they are examined out of the same in the synods". **Württemberg, *Visitationsordnung*, 1547** (Sehling 16, p. 155):

As touching doctrine and the preaching office, they shall direct them all according to the meaning and content of the Augsburg Confession and the Apology that followed thereon, and suffer nothing new or contrary thereto to go forth; and especially they

shall direct the common preachers to the same, and likewise to the later *Loci communes* of Philip, for they are examined out of the same in the synods.

Under Duke Christoph the *Iuramentum und Promissio* (Oath and promise) of the ministers named two confessions: the Augsburg and "our Confession", the Württemberg Confession of 1552. **Württemberg, *Eid der Kirchendiener*, [after 1559]** (Sehling 16, p. 424):

Oath and promise of the ministers of the church of our principality. […] And forasmuch as the explanation of such articles as are at this time in controversy in matters of faith is comprehended and set down briefly and plainly in the Augsburg Confession and in our Confession, according to the direction of the right, true, catholic sense of the prophetic and apostolic Scripture, the need of the church's office requireth that the minister of the church perform his teaching in such articles faithfully according to the explanation and content of the two said Confessions.

17.13.2 Württemberg: the mandate to sign the FC (1577)

Duke Ludwig's mandate of 1577 sent the FC to the church and told every theologian and every minister of church and school to sign it. The FC is described as wholly conformable to the earlier norm, the Württemberg Confession "delivered at Trent" included. The duke notes that the electorates of Saxony and Brandenburg had already signed. **Württemberg, *Mandat zur Unterzeichnung der Konkordienformel*, 1577** (Sehling 16, p. 445):

that they are first of all wholly conformable to the holy divine Scripture, the three old and approved creeds, the Christian Augsburg Confession, the Apology thereof, and also our Christian Confession published before this time and delivered at Trent, the Smalcald Articles, and also Luther's Catechism […]; and the oft-mentioned *formula Concordiae* is now already subscribed in both electorates, Saxony and Brandenburg, by all theologians and ministers of church and school. […] that we also in our principality should cause the oft-mentioned writings herewith sent to be signed by all our theologians and ministers of church and school (in witness of the Christian consensus).

The Limpurg church order of 1610 likewise binds its ministers to the CA and the FC (Sehling 16, p. 611).

17.13.3 Hohenlohe: an own corpus (1578), cut down (1581), and the *Gründlicher Bericht* (1603–1615)

Hohenlohe's church order of 1578 opens with a *corpus doctrinae* (body of doctrine). The church is to hold it "affirmatively and negatively", and so are both "teachers and hearers". **Hohenlohe, *Kirchenordnung*, 1578** (Sehling 15, p. 260):

the churches of this county confess themselves to the writings and books following, as wherein the eternal and unchangeable divine truth is comprehended and declared in all and every part of our true Christian religion. And both teachers and hearers shall hold the same *pro corpore doctrinae* (as the body of doctrine), affirmatively and negatively, namely: 1. The writings of the holy prophets and apostles of the Old and New Testament, as the only *norma iudicii* in all controversies. […] 2. The three old creeds, namely the Apostolic, the Nicene and Athanasius's. 3. The Augsburg Confession, as it was [delivered] in the year [15]30 to the emperor Charles V at Augsburg at the …

The apparatus records the order's later life:

- In the printer's copy the CA is qualified "unaltered in words and meaning".
- A hand in the Stuttgart copy added "7. The *formula concordiae*".
- The reissue of 1688 reads "7. The *formula concordiae*, published and subscribed in the year 1580".

The apparatus also quotes the *Verzeichnis* of 4 November 1581, in which Andreae himself advised dropping the *Repetitio* (Repetition) and Melanchthon's *Loci* (Commonplaces) from the list. As the editors note, FC II had condemned the teaching of the *Loci* on free will. The corpus was cut down to Scripture, the creeds and the CA. **Hohenlohe, *Verzeichnis* of 4 November 1581, quoted in the apparatus to the *Kirchenordnung* of 1578** (Sehling 15, p. 261):

but since the matter standeth so with the said repetition of the Augsburg Confession and the *Loci* of Philip, as is to be found in the protocol, fol. 17 and 18, Dr Jacob [Andreae] is therefore of opinion, in order to prevent strife, discord and also future danger to the church, that the said books be left out, and that in this first chapter [the church] confess itself, after God's word, to the Book of Concord, wherein the aforesaid pure books are comprehended, together with a thorough explanation of the articles in controversy. Whereupon it was resolved that, after the Bible and the three creeds, [the church] should refer itself in the church

order simply and only [!] to the Augsburg Confession as it was delivered in the year [15]30 to the emperor Charles at Augsburg, and hold the same *pro corpore doctrinae*.

Sehling's "[!]" marks the outcome. Andreae advised confessing the BoC, but the counts decided to name the CA alone. The ministers' oath of 1588 binds to the church order and its ceremonies rather than to any confession by name. **Hohenlohe, *Eid der gemeinsamen Kirchendiener*, 1588** (Sehling 15, p. 562):

Ye shall vow and swear that ye will wait upon the office of the holy ministry committed to you with your best and faithful diligence; behave yourselves altogether agreeably to the church order of the county; and change nothing therein without the foreknowledge and command of all the counts of Hohenlohe together, etc., neither take anything therefrom nor add anything thereto;

From 1603 the counts made a local doctrinal book, the *Gründlicher Bericht* (Thorough report; printed 1605), the norm in place of the FC. The partition treaties of 1609–1615 bound every minister to it by signature, oath and *Revers* (pledge). **Hohenlohe, *Erb- und Teilungsverträge*, 1609–1615** (Sehling 15, p. 674):

But in especial [we will] let it be our care with all diligence that in all and every church and school, according to the direction of the little book lately put forth in the year, etc., 1605 under the name of our Count Wolfgang (which is entitled: *A thorough report out of the holy divine Scripture of the chiefest articles of Christian doctrine*), the clear and pure word […] of God be set forth and preached unfalsified to the hearers and subjects by all and every minister of the church of this county, and unnecessary strife and divisions be so much the more prevented. *Subscriptions and duty of the ministers of the church.* Insomuch that, to fulfil all this, all ministers of the church and teachers shall promise with mouth and hand, and also subscribe such *formula doctrinae* purely with their own hands, and thereupon actually perform the customary bodily oath of duty, together with the delivery of their written *Revers*, and promise therewith

By Sehling's account, the FC was restored in Hohenlohe in 1630 (Sehling 15, pp. 17, 675–679).

17.13.4 Ulm and Limpurg

Ulm's instructions for the officials of its rural territory (1567) bound the pastors to the CA, the Apology and Ulm's own "subscribed" confession on the Lord's Supper, "which came forth publicly in print" (Sehling 17/2, p. 270). In 1586 the preachers reported that doctrine was taught throughout Ulm's territory according to Scripture, the CA, the Apology, the SA "and the Concord lately subscribed" (Sehling 17/2, p. 277).

17.13.5 Schwäbisch Hall, Wimpfen and Ravensburg

At Schwäbisch Hall, ordinands subscribed the Book of Concord together with the city's church order. **Schwäbisch Hall, ordination, *Kirchenordnung* 1614/15** (Sehling 17/1, p. 184):

Fourthly, the ordained persons shall be earnestly admonished that they will behave themselves without reproach both in doctrine and in life, etc. For the greater security thereof they shall subscribe and underwrite the Book of Concord [the Book of Concord of 1580] and this church order ["and underwrite" is wanting in the draft of 1614].

The imperial city of Wimpfen bound its clergy by oath and then by a written *Notula subscriptionis*. In it the signer confesses the CA of 1530 and the FC "with this my own handwriting", "by virtue of the oath performed". A passage struck through in the manuscript speaks of laying three fingers on the BoC printed at Tübingen in 1580. **Wimpfen, *Eid und Pflichten der Geistlichen*, [after 1577]** (Sehling 17/2, p. 530):

Note of subscription. I, N. N. of N., confess with this my own handwriting that the confession delivered at Augsburg to the emperor Charles the Fifth in the year one thousand five hundred and thirty, together with the *Formula Concordiae*, with all the points and articles incorporated in them, none excepted, are in the affirmative agreeable to the holy divine Scripture and right; and I will also with God's help abide steadfastly thereby (by virtue of the oath performed), and will not undertake to teach, preach or do anything secret or open against it all the time of my life, nor give assent to others who shall do so. Done the, etc.

Ravensburg, a city of mixed confession, had its own local "formula concordiae" (Formula of Concord), drawn up by the evangelical preachers in 1578. Every preacher signed it under the terms of his *Bestallung* (appointment), and it was renewed in 1617. **Ravensburg, *Konkordie und Kirchenordnung*, 28 January 1578, renewal of 1617** (Sehling 17/2, p. 500):

Whereas in the past year fifteen hundred and seventy-eight, for certain motives and causes alleged therein, a *formula concordiae* was drawn up by the lords preachers of the holy gospel according to the Augsburg Confession here at Ravensburg, and hath been subscribed by all the preachers appointed hitherto according to the tenor of their *Bestallungen*,

Here, as at Danzig (§17.7.3), "formula concordiae" names a local agreement among the city's own preachers, not the FC of 1577.

17.14 Franconia and Regensburg

Franconia gives the longest single record in the corpus. The Brandenburg-Ansbach priest's oath of 1528 survives with its later forms recorded in the apparatus, so that one text shows the whole development:

1. In 1528, an oath to the prince to preach "the holy gospel and word of God".
2. From 1570, an oath to the creeds, the CA, the Apology, the SA and a local "formula of concord".
3. From 1573, a printed *norma doctrinae* shared with Nürnberg.
4. From 1588, the Book of Concord.

Nürnberg refused the FC and kept the 1573 *norma doctrinae*. By the editors' account it remained Nürnberg's confessional standard into the nineteenth century. Its neighbours Windsheim and Weißenburg also refused the FC (Sehling 11, pp. 486, 656, 673). The imperial city of Regensburg, by contrast, made every minister sign the BoC with his own hand before the consistory.

17.14.1 Brandenburg-Ansbach: the priest's oath (1528, 1570, 1573, 1588)

The base text of 1528 is an oath of allegiance. It is sworn to the margrave and confirmed "by this my own handwriting", and it binds the pastor to nothing but the gospel. **Brandenburg-Ansbach-Kulmbach, *Der evangelische Priestereid*, 1528** (Sehling 11, p. 107):

I, N., elected or called pastor at N., vow and swear to the most serene, high-born prince, Lord George, margrave of Brandenburg…, hereby and by virtue of this my own handwriting, that I shall and will preach the holy gospel and word of God of the Old and New Testaments purely and clearly, and nothing that is against it,

The editors print the later wording from the surviving sworn copies. From 1570 to 1588 the clause reads (Sehling 11, p. 107):

1570 to 1588: [that I shall preach] purely and clearly the holy gospel and word of God of the Old and New Testaments, agreeably to the writings of the apostles and prophets, the three chief creeds, the Augsburg Confession and the Apology thereof, the Smalcald Articles, and the formula of concord agreed upon in the seventieth year last past between the theologians and preachers of my aforesaid gracious lord.

The "formula of concord" of 1570 is again a local one, an agreement among the margrave's own clergy. From 1573 the oath was followed by a list of books "of the *corpus doctrinae* and *norma judicii*". This is the list that Ansbach shared with Nürnberg. It names the CA in both its last edition and its first, "as ratified and subscribed at Naumburg in the year 61", and keeps the whole Melanchthonian canon. From 1577 the Concord was added (Sehling 11, p. 109):

1573–1588, added: Register of the books of the *corpus doctrinae* (body of doctrine) and *norma judicii*. The three chief creeds: the Apostolic, the Nicene and Athanasius's. Master Dr M. Luther's Small and Large Catechism. The Augsburg Confession, and especially, beside the last [edition], also the first edition, Latin and German, which was ratified and subscribed by electors and princes at Naumburg in the year 61. The Apology of the Augsburg Confession. The Smalcald Articles. The Repetition of the Augsburg Confession, which was delivered by the Elector of Saxony to the council at Trent. The *Loci communes* of Philip Melanchthon. The *Examen theologicum* of Philip Melanchthon. The *Definitio appellationum* of Philip Melanchthon. The *Responsiones* of Philip Melanchthon to the impious Bavarian articles. The *Responsiones* of Philip Melanchthon on the controversy of Stancarus. The Brandenburg church order. […] *1577–1588, added:* and especially the Book of Concord.

From 1588 the oath itself names the creeds, the CA, the Apology, the SA, both catechisms and the FC of 1580, "wherein the books just recounted are comprehended" (Sehling 11, p. 107):

Since 1588: [that I shall preach] purely and clearly the holy gospel and word of God of the Old and New Testaments, agreeably to the writings of the prophets and apostles, the three chief creeds, the Augsburg Confession and the Apology thereof, the Smalcald Articles, Luther's Small and Large Catechism, the *formula concordiae* (Formula of Concord) agreed upon in the year

1580 between the evangelical electors and princes of the Augsburg Confession and made ready in print, wherein the books just recounted are comprehended, together with a thorough explanation of the articles in controversy that arose between certain theologians of the Augsburg Confession, and also the church order published aforetime by his princely grace.

The Ansbach consistory order of 1594 made the BoC the subject of the candidate's first examination question. A man who had not read the whole book was given it to read, and examined only afterwards. **Brandenburg-Ansbach-Kulmbach, *Konsistorialordnung*, 1594** (Sehling 11, p. 388):

the appointed [members] of our consistory shall first of all ask him whether he hath read the Book of Christian Concord, published in the year 1580 between the Christian electors and estates of the Augsburg Confession and their theologians, wherein the unanimous confession of our churches is set down according to God's word as the only rule, norm and line by which all teachers and doctrines are to be judged, namely the Augsburg Confession delivered in the year 30 to Charles V, the Roman emperor, together with the Apology thereof, the three creeds, the Smalcald Articles and Luther's catechisms, with the Christian and thorough explanation of certain articles in controversy annexed; and our church order, as our *corpus doctrinae*; and whether he is wholly at one with all these writings recounted, which we hold for the divine undoubted truth, in all and every article, and acknowledgeth and holdeth them for Christian and in every way agreeable to God's word. But in case he hath not read such writings before, the whole book shall be given him straightway to read, and when he hath done so, then first shall he be admitted to the examination.

The same order binds the consistorial assessors by oath to the FC (Sehling 11, p. 384).

17.14.2 Nürnberg and its neighbours: the 1573 *norma doctrinae* and the refusal of the FC

The Ansbach-Nürnberg *norma doctrinae* of 1573 has been given above. By Sehling's introduction, it had to be signed by all the clergy in both territories in 1573 (Sehling 11, p. 486). By the editors' note it was the confessional standard of Brandenburg-Ansbach and Nürnberg from 1573 to 1588, and of Nürnberg from 1573 "into the nineteenth century" (Sehling 11, p. 109). By Sehling's introductions:

- **Refused the FC:** Nürnberg (Sehling 11, p. 486), Weißenburg (p. 656) and Windsheim (p. 673).
- **Split:** at Wertheim the clergy refused, but the count signed for himself (p. 706).
- **Signed:** Rothenburg (p. 565). So did the Swabian cities of Kaufbeuren, Kempten, Lindau and Memmingen, and the clergy of Nördlingen and Oettingen (Sehling 12).

17.14.3 Regensburg: the CA "in its right sense" (1567), the BoC signed before the consistory (1572/1588)

The imperial city's church order of 1567 receives the CA "in its right, true sense, which the letter giveth it". It condemns by name the Anabaptists, Zwinglians, Schwenckfelders, Antinomians and Osiandrians. Every minister is to be asked at his admission whether he holds the CA in this sense. **Regensburg, *Kirchenordnung* (of 1567?)** (Sehling 13, p. 453):

And as we thus receive the same confession in its right, true sense, which the letter giveth it, and the apology thereof of the year 1530, and afterward, in the year 1537, the articles set forth and subscribed at Smalcald, and also the general Christian consensus of our churches of the Augsburg Confession, and Luther's explanation; so on the other hand we reject as erroneous all that is contrary to that same sense of the Augsburg Confession, both old and new, present and to come, such as are now also certain doctrines of the Anabaptists, Zwinglians, Schwenckfelders, Antinomians and Osiandrians, until we be convinced otherwise out of the holy Scripture of God's word. And that such doctrine may remain pure in our church, and by divine grant be planted upon our descendants, it is provided that first of all the ministers of the church be all received thereupon, and be expressly asked whether they [hold] the pure Augsburg Confession in the said sense and are tainted with no other contrary doctrine.

The church government order of 1572, in its form of 1588, first records the confession of the chamberlain and council themselves (§17.17.5). It then requires every minister and schoolmaster, at the start of his appointment, to read the BoC, sign it "with his own hand" before the consistory, and declare himself on each disputed article before the council and the whole congregation. **Regensburg, *Kirchenregimentsordnung*, 1572/1588** (Sehling 13, p. 495):

every minister of church and school shall, at the very beginning of his appointment, after he hath read the said Book of Concord with diligence, subscribe it with his own hand before the consistorials, and there declare himself severally and plainly in particular concerning all sects, factions and articles in controversy according to the content of the said Book of Concord; and before an honourable council and the whole Christian congregation he shall also give a public confession and testimony thereof.

The order adds a note particular to a mixed city: "since we must, alas, dwell in this city within one ring wall with the papists", polemic is to be kept within bounds.

17.15 Strasbourg and Alsace

Strasbourg, which had signed the *Tetrapolitana* in 1530 as a Moderate Reformed city, had subscribed the CA by 1532. Its path then ran in four steps:

1. **1549:** the CA in the examination of ministers, an order issued under the Interim.
2. **1562:** a public confession at admission according to the CA and the Apology, promised "*stipulata manu*" (by handfast).
3. **1563:** the Strasbourg Concord.
4. **1577:** the FC signed "*corde et manu*" (with heart and hand).

In 1598 the FC was put into the ordination vow. Colmar, by contrast, swore its preachers to the CA and Apology in 1575 and, now Moderate Reformed, refused to add the FC in 1578.

17.15.1 The CA in the examination (1549)

The eighth question of Strasbourg's examination order asks whether the candidate acknowledges the church of Strasbourg as a true church and the CA as "the sum of right Christian doctrine". **Strasbourg, *Examensordnung*, 1549** (under the Interim; Sehling 20/1, p. 365):

The eighth: Do ye also acknowledge this present church of ours at Strasbourg for a true church of Christ our dear Lord, and the content of our Augsburg Confession for the sum of right Christian doctrine?

17.15.2 "*Stipulata manu*" (1562) and "*corde et manu*" (1577); the FC in the ordination vow (1598)

The order of service of 1577 tells the history in brief. In 1562 the council ordered that no one be admitted to the ministry who had not first made a public confession according to the CA and Apology, as newly approved at Naumburg. In 1577 the ministers agreed to admit no one who would not sign the FC "with heart and hand". **Strasbourg, *Gottesdienstordnung*, [after August 1577]** (Sehling 20/1, p. 512):

As touching the *formula doctrinae*: in the year 1562 it was commanded by certain lords deputed from the council to a reverend church convent, pastors and helpers, henceforth to receive no one into the church convent nor admit him into the ministry of Strasbourg who had not first made public his confession of all the articles of the Christian religion, as they are in the Augsburg Confession and the Apology thereof (which had at that time been approved anew and subscribed at Naumburg by the electors and princes and other estates of the Augsburg Confession); which decree of the senate all the ministers of the church then promised and undertook *stipulata manu* (by handfast) [with hand given in pledge] to obey. Afterwards, when in the year 1577 the *Formula concordiae* was delivered and handed to an honourable council at Strasbourg by the legate of the [...] duke of Württemberg, and the ministers of the church had received a copy of it from other places and had read and weighed it with diligence, they all agreed with one accord not only to behave themselves conformably thereto, but also henceforth to receive no one into the convent unless he also subscribe the said *formula concordiae* (Formula of Concord) both *corde et manu* (with heart and hand) [with heart and hand].

The footnote records that the council was more reserved than its ministers. In May 1578 it told the duke that it would not be drawn into new controversies, and it appealed to the Strasbourg Concord of 1563. In 1565 the Strasbourg clergy had also used the Pfalz-Zweibrücken Latin subscription (§17.12.4).

The church order of 1598 put the FC into the ordination questions. **Strasbourg, *Kirchenordnung*, 9 April 1598** (Sehling 20/1, pp. 640–641):

II. Do ye also believe steadfastly all that the holy divine Scripture setteth before us, and that is comprehended and repeated in the creeds or sums of our Christian faith, namely in the common Creed of the Apostles, the four great chief councils, and also in the Confession and Apology delivered by electors and princes at the diet at Augsburg in the year 1530, and the unanimous explanation thereof published in the year 1580, which is called the *Formula Concordiae*? Desire ye also to confess and teach this faith with your best faithfulness unto your end? [...] *Answer:* I believe and hold all this, and pray God that he will preserve me therein without any wavering unto his heavenly kingdom.

17.15.3 Colmar: an oath on the CA, and the refusal of the FC (1575, 1578)

Colmar introduced the Reformation in 1575. Its preachers swore, besides their citizen's oath, to preach "agreeably to the Biblical Scriptures, together with the Fathers who agree with them, the Augsburg Confession and its Apology". They also swore not to condemn publicly those "who are still at variance in certain points in the reformed church". **Colmar, *Eid der Prediger*, 22 October 1575** (Sehling 20/2, p. 501):

The preachers shall swear, beside their citizen's oath, that they will teach, preach and administer the holy sacraments only agreeably to the Biblical, holy Scriptures of the Old and New Testaments, together with the Fathers who agree with them throughout, [and] to the Augsburg Confession and the Apology thereof, without reviling, defaming and blaspheming. Item, that they will also openly condemn no one, be he of what religion he will, and especially those who are still at variance in certain points in the reformed church.

The words "and the Apology thereof" are a later addition in the margin. When the FC was urged on the city in 1578, the council, by now Moderate Reformed, declined. It had already tendered its preachers an oath, and it would not press the FC on them against that oath. **Colmar, *Ablehnung des Beitritts zur Konkordienformel*, 10 May 1578** (Moderate Reformed; Sehling 20/2, p. 509):

yet for the causes aforesaid and recounted, set forth in our letter to your princely grace, it will seem to us a very grave matter to press the *Formula concordiae* [upon our preachers], against the oath once tendered by us to our preachers and performed by them (the content whereof we have sent to your princely grace before). We therefore beseech your princely grace with humble diligence that your princely grace will hold us excused herein, and graciously [spare us] the subscription.

The sworn oath is here the reason for refusing the further subscription.

17.16 Transylvania

The Saxon church of Transylvania, outside the Empire, bound its ministers by oath to the CA. The Burzenland chapter resolved in 1573 that newly received ministers should be taught the CA so thoroughly that they could "swear to it solemnly with a good conscience" at the next convention. **Burzenland, *Beschlüsse des Burzenländer Kapitels zum Eid auf die Confessio Augustana*, 1573** (Sehling 24, p. 371):

5. Let the pastors who have lately received ministers into the ministry so inculcate upon them the reading and knowledge of the [Augsburg] [Confession], that at the next convention, after the example of the pastors, they may with a good conscience solemnly swear to it.

In 1601 the newly elected superintendent swore before the altar to keep and defend the religion "contained in the CA … the Smalcald Articles and the ecumenical creeds". **Transylvanian Saxons, *Ordnung der Superintendentenwahl*, 1601** (Sehling 24, p. 480):

The superintendent elect, before the altar, openly, Master Laurentius Kosch, pastor *Requiniensis*, going before with his voice, performed the oath that he would constantly keep and defend the religion hitherto used in the Saxon churches of Transylvania, comprehended in the prophetic and apostolic writings, exhibited and repeated in the Augsburg Confession to Charles V, and contained finally in the Smalcald Articles and the ecumenical creeds.

The FC is not named. The norm is the CA, the SA and the creeds, sworn to as the received religion of a church that lived alongside Catholics, Reformed and Unitarians.

17.17 The laity: confirmation, communion, godparents, citizenship and office

No order in the corpus requires ordinary lay people to subscribe the CA, the FC or any *corpus doctrinae* (body of doctrine). Where an order speaks of "teachers and hearers" being bound to the corpus, as at Thorn (1575, §17.7.3) and in Hohenlohe (1578, §17.13.3), it means the corpus is the standard of what the hearers are taught. It does not mean they are to sign it. The laity were bound in five other ways:

1. by **confirmation**, where a confirmation rite existed: a public profession of the catechism, a vow to remain in it, and, in the Hessian (Moderate Reformed) and Reformed forms, a submission to church discipline;

2. by the **examination before communion**, and in Reformed churches by an explicit confession of the Reformed doctrine;
3. by the **catechism test before marriage**, and in one case before admission as a burgher;
4. by rules for **godparents**;
5. for **magistrates and officials**, by oaths and, in some cities, by subscription.

17.17.1 Confirmation: profession, vow and discipline

The Hessian church orders of 1539 (Moderate Reformed), written with Bucer's help, created the evangelical confirmation. The children are questioned on the chief articles before the congregation and "give themselves publicly to Christ the Lord and his church". The pastor lays hands on them and "confirms them to Christian fellowship". **Hesse, *Ziegenhainer Zuchtordnung*, 1539** (Moderate Reformed; Sehling 8, p. 104):

The elders and preachers shall also provide that the children who have now been brought so far in Christian understanding by the catechisms that they may rightly be admitted to the Lord's table, be presented on some chief feast, as Easter, Whitsuntide and Christmas, before the whole congregation, by their parents and godparents, to the pastor at a place appointed for it, about whom the elders and all other ministers of the word shall stand. There the pastor shall question the same children on the chief parts of the Christian faith; and after the children have answered thereto, and have also there given themselves publicly to Christ the Lord and his church, the pastor shall exhort the congregation to pray the Lord for these children for steadfastness and the increase of the Holy Ghost, and shall close such prayer with a collect. After all this the pastor shall lay hands on the same children, and so confirm them in the name of the Lord and establish them in Christian fellowship, and thereupon bid them go to the Lord's table,

The Kassel church order of the same year (Moderate Reformed) gives the questions. The child professes that he is in the church by baptism and vows to remain in its fellowship. He also promises to obey God's word and to accept rebuke from the elders. The running head of the page is misprinted "1589". **Hesse, *Kasseler Kirchenordnung*, 1539** (Moderate Reformed; Sehling 8, p. 125):

Question: Art thou also in the church and congregation of Christ? *Answer:* Yea. *Question:* How camest thou thereinto? *Answer:* Through holy baptism. *Question:* What is that? *Answer:* The washing of regeneration, whereby I have been washed from inborn sin, incorporated into Christ my Lord, and clothed with him. *Question:* Wilt thou continue in the fellowship? *Answer:* Yea, by the help of the Lord, for ever. *Question:* What requireth this fellowship of the church of Christ? *Answer:* That I keep myself in all obedience to God's word, and hear the same with a rightly believing heart from the appointed ministers of the church at the set times, and chiefly on the Sundays; and also, if the elders of the church or other Christians, whosoever they be, rebuke me for sin, that I receive it in all humility for amendment,

This is a vow of membership, not of confession. The child binds himself to the church's fellowship and discipline, and no book is named. Strasbourg's church order of 1553 introduced the same rite, "after confession made and free surrender to the discipline and obedience of the church". **Strasbourg, *Kirchenordnung von Johannes Marbach*, 1553** (Sehling 20/1, p. 396):

To set up again in the church this Christian and altogether needful ceremony: to present publicly to the church the baptized children, after they have now learned the catechism, and, after confession made and free surrender into the discipline and obedience of the church, to commend them to the Lord our God and to his dear congregation with the laying on of hands and believing prayer,

The Reformed refugee church order of Marten Micron (Reformed), used in East Frisia, has three questions. They ask for answers on the chief parts of the catechism, for a vow to remain in "this confession of faith" and renounce the world and Satan, and for a vow to submit to Christian discipline. **East Frisia (Reformed), *Microns Ordinancien* (1554), 1565** (Sehling 7/1, p. 607):

First, that they give answer, each one severally and most briefly, upon the most special chief parts of the Christian religion (whereupon they are asked after the order of the small catechism). Secondly, whether they will also by the grace of God abide steadfast in this confession of faith, order their life thereafter, and renounce the world and Satan with all their pomp? *Answer:* Yea, we [will]. Thirdly, whether they will not also willingly submit themselves to Christian correction (according to the word of God)? *Answer:* Yea, we [will].

Electoral Saxony's order of 1580 has no laying on of hands. It teaches that the catechism examination is itself the "right Christian confirmation": the confirming of the faith that the godparents confessed at baptism in the child's stead. **Electoral Saxony, *Kirchenordnung* of Elector August, 1580** (Sehling 1, p. 425):

And the pastors and ministers of the church shall diligently instruct the people, and inform them with good ground, that this is the right Christian confirmation or firming, that is, the confirming of the faith which the godparents confessed in the stead of the newly baptized child, and whereupon also the child was baptized: namely when they are reminded of the same in this examination, and are diligently exhorted to follow it all their life long.

The confirmation rites themselves are treated in Chapter 13, §13.6, and the instruction before first communion and confirmation in Chapter 15, §§15.11.2–15.11.3.

17.17.2 Admission to communion

The Lutheran orders required every communicant to be "explored", that is, examined and absolved, beforehand. Schweinfurt grounds this rule in the CA and the Apology themselves. **Schweinfurt, *Kirchenordnung*, 1543** (Sehling 11, p. 640):

no one shall be admitted to the most worthy sacrament unless he have announced himself to the chaplain the evening before, or in the morning during or after matins, in every manner as our [divines] say out and confess concerning it in the Augsburg Confession with clear, bright, plain words, namely in the article of the Mass: *None are admitted unless they have first been examined*; and in the Apology: *The sacrament is given to those who will use it, after they have been examined and absolved.*

Pfalz-Neuburg's general articles of 1576 apply the same rule to the young. They add a catechism test before marriage. **Pfalz-Neuburg, *Generalartikel*, 1576** (Sehling 13, p. 176):

2. The pastors and ministers of the church shall also admit no one among the young people to the most worthy sacrament who hath not learned his catechism and cannot give a sufficient account of his faith out of the same. 3. When they also enter into the state of marriage, the two shall not be proclaimed nor blessed until they have well learned the six chief parts of Christian doctrine.

The Württemberg visitation order of 1557 deals with those who stay away from the Supper "on account of Zwinglian, Schwenckfeldian, Anabaptist or other sects". They are not refused a confession they never offered. They are visited privately, twice, and then a third time before two or three of the discipline-men. **Württemberg, *Visitationsordnung*, 1557** (Sehling 16, p. 331):

or if anyone would withdraw himself from the Supper of Christ on account of Zwinglian, Schwenckfeldian, Anabaptist or other sects, every minister of the church shall be bound to send for the same person alone, the first and the second time, and so instruct him privately and discreetly with all good Christian teachings and exhortations.

The Reformed orders went further. Nassau-Dillenburg (1582), once it had turned Reformed, admitted to the Supper only those who had made a confession of "the Reformed doctrine". This applied to strangers as well. **Nassau-Dillenburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1582** (Reformed; Sehling 10, p. 163):

43. Let no one be admitted to the Lord's Supper unless he have made a confession of the Reformed doctrine after the custom of the church, and have the testimony of an honest life; without which not even strangers are to be admitted.

This is the nearest thing in the corpus to a lay confessional test, and it is Reformed.

The examination of communicants in place of private confession is treated in Chapter 13, §13.17.4, and confession and communion as a duty of the laity in Chapter 15, §15.8.3.

17.17.3 Marriage and citizenship

A test of catechism knowledge could be a condition of civil standing. In the Reformed Kurpfalz in 1599 couples who could not recite the chief parts were not to be married. No such "ignorant" was to be received as a burgher or member of the commune without a written certificate from his pastor. **Kurpfalz, *Mandat zum Katechismusunterricht*, 1 February 1599** (Reformed; Sehling 19/2, p. 890):

[ye shall] proclaim or bless no new married couple that cannot recite the chief parts; as to this end also our most gracious lord hath caused the former command to the officials to be renewed, that none of such ignorant persons shall be received as a burgher or member of the commune, unless he have a written certificate and testimony to show from the pastor of the place (where he purposeth to settle) that he can at the least recite them.

Earlier, the Margraviate of Baden's mandate against the Anabaptists (1543) had made a negative test a condition of settlement. One version, C in the apparatus, adds a clause: no one is to be received as burgher or *Hintersasse* unless it was first certain that he did not belong to the sect, with a sealed certificate of his former conduct. **Baden, *Wiedertäufermandat*, 1543, version C** (Sehling 16, p. 515):

The officials also shall henceforth receive or suffer no one as burgher [text destroyed] or as *Hintersasse*, unless it be first made certain that he is not an adherent of this seducing sect, nor hath kept himself before in suspected places, and that he can show, beside his certificate of free birth, a true and sealed certificate of his former conduct and life.

The catechism examination before marriage is treated in Chapter 15, §15.11.4.

17.17.4 Godparents

The godparent was the one lay office in the Church's rites, and the orders differ on whether he must share the parish's confession.

Excluded. The Limpurg visitors (1611) were to ask whether the pastor "admits ignorant children and heterodox persons to be godparents". **Limpurg, *Visitationsordnung*, 1611** (Sehling 16, p. 629):

23. Whether he also admit children without understanding and heterodox persons to be godparents.

Examined first. The synod of Wied (1564, Reformed) barred "men of another religion, who detest our evangelical doctrine", unless they had first been examined by the ministers and given an account of their faith. **Wied, *Synodalbeschlüsse*, 5 June 1564** (Reformed; Sehling 19/1, p. 466):

6. That boys be not admitted as sponsors of infants in the administration of holy baptism, nor yet men of another religion who detest our evangelical doctrine, unless they have first been examined by the ministers of the church and have given an account of their faith.

Admitted with discretion. Nassau-Weilburg (1609) told its pastors that people who did not hold the unaltered CA in every point were not to be driven from the font, unless they were open blasphemers. The reason given is that the institution of godparents is "not an express command of God". **Nassau-Weilburg, *Erläuterungspunkte zur Kirchenordnung*, 1609** (Sehling 10, p. 329):

Forasmuch as it sometimes happeneth that persons who are still addicted in many things to the superstition of the papists, or otherwise cannot find themselves right in all points of the pure evangelical doctrine according to the unaltered Augsburg Confession delivered in the year 30, are asked to be godparents: the ministers of the church shall in such case deal reasonably and prudently (since the ordinance of godparents is not an express command of God, but was ordained by men for good and weighty reasons), and not hastily drive away and keep altogether from holy baptism anyone who is not an open blasphemer of God, of his holy word and of the most worthy sacraments.

Both religions admitted. In biconfessional Soest the council confirmed in 1583 that, for the sake of peace, godparents of both religions, Roman and Augsburg, had been freely admitted, and it left the practice unchanged. **Soest, *Anweisung zu den Taufpaten*, 8 June 1583** (Sehling 22, p. 478):

Forasmuch as hitherto, for the preserving of good peace and unity between the estates related to both religions, as well the Roman church as the unfalsified Augsburg Confession delivered in the year thirty to the imperial majesty, it hath been free and permitted without distinction for the one to hold, to stand at and to attend the sacrament of holy baptism with the other,

Godparents at baptism are treated in Chapter 13, §13.3.8. The wider dispute over papist and Calvinist godparents is set out in §18.4.3.

17.17.5 Magistrates and officials

Lay office-holders were bound more strictly than the common people:

- **Councils.** The Heilbronn council swore in 1530, soon after the Diet of Augsburg, to stand by the council's majority "whether in the matter of the gospel or otherwise". The accompanying council ordinance says that the whole citizenry had been asked its mind and found willing.

- **The council as confessor.** The council of Regensburg made its own confession to the creeds, the CA, the Apology, the SA and Luther's catechism (1572).
- **Assessors.** Consistorial assessors swore to the church's confession in Ernestine Saxony (1569, §17.6.1), Prussia (1584, §17.7.2) and Ansbach (1594, §17.14.1).
- **City officials.** At Hildesheim in 1593 the burgomasters, syndics, physicians and secretaries signed the FC and its Apology "with their own hand" (§17.10.1).
- **Elders.** The Reformed Kurpfalz had its elders vow to the presbytery order (about 1601).

Heilbronn, *Eid des Heilbronner Rates auf den neuen Glauben*, 18 November 1530 (Sehling 17/1, p. 290):

Every one shall vow and swear that, in whatsoever concerneth and toucheth the common city and an honourable council, be it of the gospel or in other ways, he will stand and abide by an honourable council and the majority thereof, and will stake body and goods [thereon], and will act to the profit of the common city according to his best ability.

Regensburg, *Kirchenregimentsordnung*, 1572/1588 (Sehling 13, p. 494):

Afterwards an honourable chamberlain and council also confess themselves to the three creeds or confessions of faith, namely the Apostles', the Nicene and Athanasius's; item to the pure, unfalsified Augsburg Confession, as it was delivered to the emperor Charles the Fifth at the diet held at Augsburg in the lesser number [of years] in the thirtieth; to the Apology set forth thereupon; to the Smalcald Articles and the catechism of the dear man of God, Martin Luther; as such writings and confessions as are drawn from the ground of God's word, and agree and accord with the writings of the Old and New Testament; even as all Christian electors and estates of the Augsburg Confession, attached to the same in its right and proper sense, together with their ministers of church and school, have confessed it with one accord and Christianly with heart, hand and mouth, and have subscribed the same.

Kurpfalz, *Presbyterordnung*, about 1601 (Reformed; Sehling 14, p. 598). The inspectors are to have the newly chosen elders vow to the published order, which they must first have read or heard read, and so confirm them:

and ye shall cause them to vow upon this our published ordinance (which they shall before have either read or heard read), and so confirm them and receive them under duty.

The oaths of homage and the prayer for the magistrate are treated in Chapter 13, §13.13, and the magistrate's church duties in Chapter 15, §15.10.

17.18 Table by order

The table lists every order quoted or cited above, grouped by region and in date order within each region. **Norm** gives the documents the order names, in its own sequence. "Scr" is Scripture and "Cr" the three creeds. Qualifiers the order itself uses are in brackets: "unalt." = unaltered or "as delivered in 1530"; "1st ed." = first edition. **Bound** says who is bound. **Form** is the form of binding (§17.4):

- *list*: book list
- *vis.*: visitation question
- *exam*: examination
- *promise*: promise, *Revers* (pledge) or *Bestallung* (appointment)
- *oath*: sworn oath
- *vow*: ordination "Yea"
- *sign*: subscription with one's own hand
- *decl.*: declaration of the territory's or the council's confession, no personal form stated

Saxony, Thuringia and central Germany

Order	Date	Norm	Bound	Form	§
Albertine Saxony, *Gemeiner bericht der visitatorn*	1540	Scr, CA, Apol; *Loci* (Commonplaces), Luther's postil	pastors	list	17.5.1

Order	Date	Norm	Bound	Form	§
Albertine Saxony, *General-Artikel*	1557	Bible, CA, *Repetitio* (Repetition), agenda, *Loci*	parish, pastor, sexton	list	17.5.1
Electoral Saxony, *Kirchenordnung* of Elector August	1580	Scr, CA (unalt.), Apol, SA, SC, LC, FC (as "the Torgau declaration")	every pastor	sign (BoC)	17.5.3
Ernestine Saxony, *Instruction*	1554	Bible, Hauspostil, CA, SA, *Unterricht der Visitatoren*	parish	list	17.6.1
Ernestine Saxony, *Ordnung … consistorii zu Jena*	1569	Scr, Cr, CA (1530), Apol, SA; against Weimar *Confutationes* (Confutations)	consistory members	public confession	17.6.1
Henneberg, *Visitations- und Consistorial-Ordnung*	1574/77	Scr, Cr, CA, Apol, SA, SC "*pro norma doctrinae*" (as the norm of doctrine)	pastors	vis.	17.6.2
Henneberg, *Kirchenordnung* of Georg Ernst	1582	Scr, Cr, CA, Apol, SA, SC, LC, FC	ordinands	sign; vow	17.6.2
Mansfeld, *Kirchen-agenda*	1580	Scr, Cr, CA (1st, unalt.), Apol, SA, SC, LC, Luther's writings, Mansfeld confession 1565	the county's preachers	decl.	17.6.3
Mansfeld, *Consistorial ordnung*	1586	Bible, Cr, CA, Apol, Luther, catechisms, Mansfeld confession 1565, BoC	consistory	decl.	17.6.3
Archbishopric of Magdeburg, *Instruktion zur Visitation*	1583	Scr, Cr, CA (unalt.), Apol, SA, SC, LC; FC "grounded" on them	pastors	vis.	17.6.4
Halberstadt, *Instruktion für die Visitation*	1588	Bible, CA, Apol, SA, catechisms, Brunswick KO's *corpus doctrinae* (body of doctrine)	pastors	list; vis.	17.6.5
Anhalt, *Instructio commissariorum*	1588	Bible, Cr, CA and Apol ("of the year [15]30 and [15]33"), SA, SC, LC	pastors	list ("*pro confessione*")	17.6.6

The east: Silesia, Prussia, the Polish cities, Pomerania

Order	Date	Norm	Bound	Form	§
Prussia, *Von Erwehlung der beiden bischoff*	1568	*Corpus doctrinae Prutenicum* 1567; SC	pastors	decl.	17.7.2
Prussia, *Consistorialordnung*	1584	"our church's unanimous confession"	president, assessors	oath	17.7.2
Pomerania, *Kerckenordeninge*	1563/69	Luther's writings; *Loci*, Apol; *Corpus Pomeranicum*	parish, ministers	list	17.7.4
Pomerania, *Statuta synodica*	1574	"pious consensus of heavenly doctrine"; synod statutes, KO, agenda	all ministers	promise (handshake)	17.7.4
Thorn, *Kirchenordnung*	1575	SC, LC, CA (royal privilege)	"teachers and hearers"	decl.	17.7.3
Danzig, *Decret des Senats*	1586	CA and *Notel* (note); BoC forbidden	preachers	decl.	17.7.3

Order	Date	Norm	Bound	Form	§
Brieg, *Kirchenordnung*	1592	Scr, Cr, CA, Apol, Luther, *CPhil*, Mecklenburg agenda	preachers	list	17.7.1
Danzig, *Kirchenordnung*	1612	Scr, CA 1530, city *Notel* ("formula concordiae")	preachers	sign (*Notel*)	17.7.3

The Baltic and Schleswig-Holstein

Order	Date	Norm	Bound	Form	§
Mecklenburg, *Kirchenordnung*	1552	doctrine confessed in the examination	ordinands	promise	17.8.1
Kurland, *Kirchenordnung*	1570	Scr, CA, Apol, Cr, ancient councils, SA, *CPhil* 1560, SC	new preachers	decl.	17.8.2
Rostock, *Statuta et decreta*	1573 (1577)	Scr, Cr, CA 1530, Apol, SA, Mecklenburg KO, SC, LC, Luther, Lüneburg Articles, FC	ministerium	sign (FC 1577)	17.8.1
Schleswig-Holstein-Gottorp, *Predigereid*	1574	Scr, Cr, CA, Apol, SA, SC, LC (on the Supper)	preachers	oath	17.8.4
Lauenburg, *Kirchenordnung*	1585	Scr, Cr, CA (unalt.), Apol, SA, Luther, SC, LC, "or FC"	pastors	promise	17.8.3
Schleswig-Holstein-Gottorp, *Neuer Predigereid*	1607	Scripture only	ordinands	oath	17.8.4

Lower Saxony

Order	Date	Norm	Bound	Form	§
Lüneburg, *Kirchenordnung*	1564	Scr, Cr, SC, CA and Apol 1530	the prince	decl.	17.9.3
Göttingen, *Kirchenordnung der stadt Göttingen*	1568	CA 1530, Apol, SA, SC, city KO approved by Luther	council and ministry	decl.	17.9.4
Braunschweig-Wolfenbüttel, *Kirchenordnung*	1569	Scr, Cr, CA "as explained" by Apol, SA, catechism, Luther	all pastors	decl.	17.9.1
Brunswick city, *Articuli … subscribendi*	1571	Scr, Cr, CA 1530, Apol 1531, SA, catechisms; against Lüneburg Articles' errors	new ministers	sign	17.9.2
Brunswick city, *Vokationsordnung*	1571	the city's *corpus doctrinae*	new preachers	sign; vow	17.9.2
Lüneburg city, *Kirchenordnung*	1575	Scr, Cr, CA 1530, Apol, SA, catechisms, Lübeck-Hamburg-Lüneburg confession 1548	ordinands	written confession, checked	17.9.3
Hoya, *Kirchenordnung*	1581	Scr, Cr, CA (unalt.), Apol, SA, SC, LC ("laymen's Bible"), FC	pastors	decl.	17.9.5
Goslar, *Verzeichnis der … Lehrschriften*	1591/95	Scr, Cr, SC, LC, CA 1530, Apol (1st print), SA 1537, Lower Saxon Confession 1571, FC	ministry, schoolmasters	sign	17.9.6

Order	Date	Norm	Bound	Form	§
Calenberg-Göttingen, *Gandersheimer Landtagsabschied*	1601	ducal KO, *Corpus Julium*; town KO	preachers in the four towns	sign	17.9.4

The north-west

Order	Date	Norm	Bound	Form	§
Bremen, *Berufung von Markus Mening* (Philippist)	1570	Cr, CA, Apol, *Saxonica* (Saxon [Confession]), *CPhil*	preacher	call (*Berufung*)	17.10.5
Bremen, *Einigung des geistlichen Ministeriums* (Philippist)	1572	Scr, Cr, CA, *CPhil*, Verden recess	ministry, future ministers	decl.	17.10.5
Oldenburg, *Kirchenordnung*	1573	Scr, Cr, CA, Apol, SA, catechism, *CPhil* (*Repetitio*, *Loci*, *Examen*, *Responsiones*)	pastors	list	17.10.4
Bremen, settlement of the Naso conflict (Philippist)	1575	adds the Frankfurt Recess	ministry	decl.	17.10.5
Peine (Hildesheim), *Eid und obligation der prediger*	1574/89	Scr, Cr (Christology), CA, Apol, SA, catechisms	preachers	oath	17.10.1
Oldenburg, *Bestallungen*	1574–1608	CA, catechism, KO; + FC (1586); CA "incorporated in the FC" (1608)	pastors, superintendent	promise	17.10.4
Soest, *Artikel der Prediger*	1590	Bible, Cr, CA 1530, Apol, SA, SC, LC, FC	all ministers	sign	17.10.7
Hildesheim, council decision (in Sehling's introduction)	1593	FC and Erfurt Apology	superintendent, burgomasters, syndics, physicians, secretaries, preachers, schoolmasters	sign	17.10.1
East Frisia, *Marienhafer Kirchenordnung*	1593	Scr, Cr, CA (unfalsified), Apol, SC, LC, FC 1580	pastors	decl.	17.10.6
East Frisia, *Konkordaten* (Reformed–Lutheran treaty)	1599	CA only	the land	treaty	17.10.6
Verden, *Kirchenordnung*	1606	CA "as explained" by Apol, SA, SC, LC	the diocese	decl.	17.10.2
Oldenburg, visitation articles	1609	FC, KO; against Calvinist doctrine	pastors	vis.	17.10.4
Osnabrück, *Superintendenten- und Predigerordnung*	1610	CA (unalt.) as explained by Apol, Wittenberg Concord 1536, SA, SC, LC, BoC	preachers	decl.	17.10.3

Order	Date	Norm	Bound	Form	§
Hildesheim, *Schulordnung*	1574/1618	FC and its Apology	teachers	sign	17.10.1

Hesse and its neighbours

Order	Date	Norm	Bound	Form	§
Nassau-Diez, *Revers der Kirchendiener*	1564	Scr, Cr, CA, *Loci*	new preachers	promise	17.11.4
Hesse, *Abschied* (Philippist)	1571	Scr, Cr, CA, Apol, SA, SC, *CPhil*	synod's pastors	decl.	17.11.1
Hesse, *Agende* (Philippist)	1574	Scr (sole *norma iudicii*), Cr, CA ("symbol of our time"); var. + Apol, *CPhil*	pastors	decl.	17.11.1
Nassau-Weilburg, *Kirchenordnung*	1574/76	Scr, CA (unalt.)	pastors	vis.	17.11.5
Nassau-Dillenburg, *Kirchenordnung* (Reformed)	1582	"the Reformed doctrine"	communicants	confession before Supper	17.17.2
Ysenburg-Birstein, *Kirchenordnung*	1588	Scr, Cr, CA (unalt.), Apol, SA, SC, LC	pastors	decl.	17.11.5
Frankfurt, *Agende*	1589	Scr, CA, SA, SC, LC, BoC	ordinands	vow	17.11.3
Waldeck, revised ordination form	about 1584	Scr, Cr, CA, Apol, SA, SC, LC, FC	ordinands	vow	17.11.2
Hessen-Kassel, Katzenelnbogen *Diensteid* (Philippist)	1598	Scr, Cr, four councils, Leo's Tome, CA, Apol, SA, synodal *Abschiede*; against ubiquity	pastors	oath	17.11.1
Hessen-Darmstadt, *Mandat zur Beibehaltung der CA*	1617	Scr, CA (unalt.); against papists, Zwinglians, Calvinists, Anabaptists	theologians, professors, preachers, schoolmasters	oath	17.11.1

The Palatinates

Order	Date	Norm	Bound	Form	§
Pfalz-Neuburg, *Bestallung*	1555	—	pastor	promise ("with fealty given by the hand")	17.12.1
Kurpfalz, *Kirchenordnung* of Ottheinrich	1556	Scr, Cr, CA and Apol 1530 ("unfalsified sense"), SA, Luther's catechism	pastors	decl.	17.12.1
Pfalz-Neuburg, *Mandat gegen die Kalvinisten*	1564	Scr, CA, Apol, Wittenberg Concord 1536, SA, KO	ministers	decl.	17.12.3
Pfalz-Zweibrücken, *Bekenntnisverpflichtung*	1564	Scr, four creeds (incl. Te Deum), four councils, CA 1530, SA, …	ministers	sign ("*mente atque manu*")	17.12.4
Pfalz-Neuburg, *Generalartikel*	1576	Scr, Cr, CA 1530 ("symbol of our time"), Apol, SA, SC =	pastors	decl.	17.12.3

Order	Date	Norm	Bound	Form	§
		corpus doctrinae			
Kurpfalz, *Kirchendienerbestallung*	1580	Luther's catechism, CA, Apol, BoC	ministers	promise	17.12.1
Upper Palatinate, *Kirchenratsinstruktion* (Reformed)	1585	Scr, Cr, four councils, CA and Apol as repeated at Frankfurt and Naumburg; release from BoC	church council; ministers	decl.	17.12.2
Kurpfalz, *Kirchendienerbestallung* (Reformed)	1586	Heidelberg Catechism (large and small), CA, Apol	ministers	promise	17.12.1
Kurpfalz, *Schuldienerbestallung* (Reformed)	1601	(the *Bestallung*)	schoolmasters	promise "in the stead of an oath"; sign	17.12.1
Hintere Grafschaft Sponheim, *Generalartikel*	1608	FC "*pro symbolo*" (as a creed)	pastors	list; written declaration	17.12.5

Württemberg, Hohenlohe and Swabia

Order	Date	Norm	Bound	Form	§
Württemberg, *Visitationsordnung*	1547	CA, Apol, later *Loci*	preachers	exam	17.13.1
Württemberg, *Eid der Kirchendiener*	after 1559	Scr, CA, Württemberg Confession	ministers	oath	17.13.1
Ulm, *Anweisungen für Amtsträger*	1567	CA, Apol, Ulm Supper confession	pastors	decl.	17.13.4
Württemberg, FC mandate	1577	Scr, Cr, CA, Apol, Württemberg Confession, SA, SC, FC	all theologians, ministers of church and school	sign	17.13.2
Hohenlohe, *Kirchenordnung*	1578	Scr (*norma iudicii*), Cr, CA, …; + FC (by hand)	"teachers and hearers"	decl.	17.13.3
Ravensburg, local "formula concordiae"	1578/1617	local preachers' concord	preachers	sign	17.13.5
Wimpfen, *Notula subscriptionis*	after 1577	CA 1530, FC	clergy	oath; sign	17.13.5
Hohenlohe, *Verzeichnis* (apparatus)	1581	Scr, Cr, CA 1530 only	—	decl.	17.13.3
Hohenlohe, *Eid der gemeinsamen Kirchendiener*	1588	the county KO	ministers	oath	17.13.3
Hohenlohe, *Erb- und Teilungsverträge*	1609–15	CA 1530; *Gründlicher Bericht* 1605	ministers, teachers	sign; oath; *Revers*	17.13.3
Limpurg, *Kirchenordnung*	1610	CA, FC	ministers	sign	17.13.2
Schwäbisch Hall, *Kirchenordnung*	1614/15	BoC, city KO	ordinands	sign	17.13.5

Franconia and Regensburg

Order	Date	Norm	Bound	Form	§
Brandenburg-Ansbach, *Priestereid*	1528	"the holy gospel and word of God"	pastors	oath; sign	17.14.1
Regensburg, *Kirchenordnung*	1567?	CA ("true sense"), Apol 1530, SA 1537, Luther; against named sects	ministers	exam question	17.14.3
Brandenburg-Ansbach, *Priestereid* (variant)	1570–88	Scr, Cr, CA, Apol, SA, local formula of 1570	pastors	oath	17.14.1
Brandenburg-Ansbach and Nürnberg, *norma doctrinae*	1573	Cr, SC, LC, CA (last and 1st ed.), Apol, SA, *Repetitio*, *Loci*, *Examen*, *Responsiones*, Brandenburg KO; + BoC (1577)	all clergy	oath; sign	17.14.1–17.14.2
Regensburg, *Kirchenregimentsordnung*	1572/88	Cr, CA (unfalsified), Apol, SA, SC; BoC	council (decl.); every minister and schoolmaster	sign	17.14.3, 17.17.5
Brandenburg-Ansbach, *Priestereid* (variant)	from 1588	Scr, Cr, CA, Apol, SA, SC, LC, FC 1580, KO	pastors	oath	17.14.1
Brandenburg-Ansbach, *Konsistorialordnung*	1594	BoC and KO "as our *corpus doctrinae*"	candidates; assessors	exam; oath	17.14.1

Strasbourg, Alsace, Transylvania

Order	Date	Norm	Bound	Form	§
Strasbourg, *Examensordnung*	1549	CA	candidates	exam	17.15.1
Strasbourg, council decree (in *Gottesdienstordnung* 1577)	1562	CA, Apol (as at Naumburg)	ministers	public confession; "*stipulata manu*" (by handfast)	17.15.2
Strasbourg, *Gottesdienstordnung*	1577	FC	ministers	sign ("*corde et manu*")	17.15.2
Burzenland chapter	1573	CA	new ministers	oath	17.16
Colmar, *Eid der Prediger*	1575	Scr, Fathers, CA, Apol	preachers	oath	17.15.3
Colmar, refusal of the FC (Moderate Reformed)	1578	—	—	—	17.15.3
Strasbourg, *Kirchenordnung*	1598	Scr, Apostles' Creed, four councils, CA, Apol 1530, FC 1580	ordinands	vow	17.15.2
Transylvanian Saxons, *Superintendentenwahl*	1601	Scr, CA, SA, ecumenical creeds	superintendent	oath	17.16

The laity

Order	Date	What is required	Of whom	§
Ziegenhain *Zuchtordnung*; Kassel KO (Hesse; Moderate Reformed)	1539	catechism examination, self-surrender to Christ and the church, vow to remain in the fellowship and accept discipline	confirmands	17.17.1

Order	Date	What is required	Of whom	§
Heilbronn, council oath	1530	to stand by the council "in the matter of the gospel"	councillors	17.17.5
Schweinfurt, KO	1543	announcement and exploration before communion, per CA and Apol	communicants	17.17.2
Baden, Anabaptist mandate (var. C)	1543	proof of not belonging to the sect	new burghers	17.17.3
Strasbourg, Marbach KO	1553	confession and submission to discipline	confirmands	17.17.1
Württemberg, *Visitationsordnung*	1557	private admonition of sectarian abstainers	non-communicants	17.17.2
Wied, synod (Reformed)	1564	examination of godparents of another religion	godparents	17.17.4
Micron's *Ordinancien* (Reformed)	1554/1565	catechism answers, vow of constancy, submission to discipline	confirmands	17.17.1
Pfalz-Neuburg, *Generalartikel*	1576	catechism before first communion; six chief parts before marriage	the young, bridal couples	17.17.2
Electoral Saxony, KO	1580	catechism examination as "confirmation" of the baptismal faith	children	17.17.1
Nassau-Dillenburg, KO (Reformed)	1582	confession of the Reformed doctrine	communicants, strangers	17.17.2
Soest	1583	godparents of both religions admitted	godparents	17.17.4
Hildesheim	1593	signature to FC and Erfurt Apology	city officials	17.10.1
Kurpfalz, mandate (Reformed)	1599	recite the chief parts	bridal couples; new burghers	17.17.3
Kurpfalz, *Presbyterordnung* (Reformed)	about 1601	vow to the order	elders	17.17.5
Nassau-Weilburg, *Erläuterungspunkte*	1609	heterodox godparents admitted with discretion	godparents	17.17.4
Limpurg, *Visitationsordnung*	1611	heterodox godparents excluded	godparents	17.17.4

17.19 Concordance of the orders quoted

Every order quoted in this chapter is listed below by region, in the order in which it is quoted. The table gives:

- **Sehling**: the volume and pages in Sehling's edition.
- **Doc**: the `eko.db` document that holds the text, for full-text lookup. A single database record may hold several orders.
- **§**: the sections where the order is quoted.

Saxony, Thuringia and central Germany

Order	Sehling	Doc	§
Albertine Saxony, *Gemeiner bericht der visitatorn an die pfarrer und dorfschaften*, 1540	1, p. 285	32	17.5.1
Albertine Saxony, *General-Artikel und gemeiner Bericht*, 8 May 1557	1, p. 325	37	17.5.1

Order	Sehling	Doc	§
Electoral Saxony, *Kirchenordnung* of Elector August, 1580	1, pp. 380, 420, 425	44	17.5.3, 17.17.1
Ernestine Saxony, *Instruction Johans Friderichen des mittlern, Johans Wilhelm und Johans Friderichen d. j.*, 1554	1, p. 227	21	17.6.1
Ernestine Saxony, *Ordnung und reformation ecclesiastici consistorii zu Jena*, 1569	1, p. 234	24	17.6.1
Henneberg, *Visitations- und Consistorial-Ordnung*, 1574, 1577	2, p. 291	1247	17.6.2
Henneberg, *Des durchlauchtigen hochgebornen fürsten und herrn, herrn Georg Ernsten, kirchen ordnung*, 1582	2, pp. 300, 324	1247	17.6.2
Mansfeld, *Kirchen-agenda für die prediger der grafschaft Mansfeld*, 1580	2, p. 215	1241	17.6.3
Mansfeld, *Gräflich mansfeldische geistliche consistorial ordnung*, 1586	2, p. 201	1240	17.6.3
Archbishopric of Magdeburg, *Instruktion zur Visitation*, 25 May 1583	2, p. 419	1256	17.6.4
Bishopric of Halberstadt, *Instruktion für die Visitation*, 8 August 1588	2, pp. 468–469	1259	17.6.5
Anhalt, *Instructio commissariorum in potestate executionis der vorgenommenen Visitation*, 21 September 1588	2, p. 579	1262	17.6.6

Silesia, Prussia, the Polish cities and Pomerania

Order	Sehling	Doc	§
Brieg, *Kirchenordnung für Brieg*, 1592	3, pp. 444–445	1809	17.7.1
Brieg, *Kirchenordnung für Brieg*, 1592 (chapter *De corpore doctrinae* [Of the body of doctrine])	3, p. 448	1810	17.7.1
Prussia, *Von Erwehlung der beiden bischoff*, 1568	4, p. 111	1833	17.7.2
Prussia, *Consistorialordnung*, 1584	4, p. 125	1834	17.7.2
Thorn, *Kirchenordnung für Thorn*, 1575	4, p. 234	1844	17.7.3
Danzig, *Decret des Senats*, 23 October 1586	4, p. 192	1844	17.7.3
Danzig, *Kirchenordnung für Danzig*, 1612	4, p. 210	1844	17.7.3
Pomerania, *Kerckenordeninge*, 1569	4, p. 382	1862	17.7.4
Pomerania, *Statuta synodica*, 1574	4, p. 492	1868	17.7.4

Mecklenburg, Kurland, Lauenburg and Schleswig-Holstein

Order	Sehling	Doc	§
Mecklenburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1552	5, p. 192	1922	17.8.1
Rostock, *Statuta et decreta*, 1573	5, p. 285	1934	17.8.1
Kurland, *Kurländische Kirchenordnung*, 1570	5, p. 70	1907	17.8.2
Lauenburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1585	5, p. 402	1953	17.8.3
Schleswig-Holstein-Gottorp, *Predigereid*, 1574	23, p. 365	1619	17.8.4

Order	Sehling	Doc	§
Schleswig-Holstein-Gottorp, *Mitteilung über den Erlaß eines neuen Predigereides*, 4 January 1607	23, p. 415	1628	17.8.4
Schleswig-Holstein-Gottorp, *Neuer Predigereid*, 4 January 1607	23, p. 416	1628	17.8.4

Lower Saxony

Order	Sehling	Doc	§
Braunschweig-Wolfenbüttel, *Kirchenordnung* of Duke Julius, 1569	6/1, pp. 91–92	1974	17.9.1
Brunswick, *Articuli, qui subscribendi proponuntur illis qui ad ministerium in hac ecclesia recipiuntur*, 1571	6/1, p. 471	1987	17.9.2
Brunswick, *Vokationsordnung für die Prediger*, 1571	6/1, p. 457	1985	17.9.2
Principality of Lüneburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1564	6/1, p. 534	2003	17.9.3
Lüneburg city, *Kirchenordnung der Stadt Lüneburg*, 1575	6/1, p. 654	2017	17.9.3
Calenberg-Göttingen, *Gandersheimer Landtagsabschied*, 1601	6/2, p. 894	2042	17.9.4
Göttingen, *Christliche und in Gottes wort … gegründte kirchenordnung der stadt Göttingen*, 1568	6/2, p. 916	2044	17.9.4
Hoya, *Kirchenordnung*, 1581	6/2, p. 1131	2064	17.9.5
Goslar, *Verzeichnis der in Goslar gültigen Lehrschriften*, 11 May 1595	7/2.2, pp. 339–340	2208	17.9.6

The north-west

Order	Sehling	Doc	§
Peine, *Eid und obligation der prediger im herzogtumb Schleswiegk wie auch in ihren fürstl. gn. pfandgericht und ampt Peina*, [1574/89]	7/2.1, p. 787	2130	17.10.1
Hildesheim, council decision on the subscription of the *Formula Concordiae*, 30 August 1593, quoted in Sehling's introduction	7/2.1, p. 817	2133	17.10.1
Hildesheim, *Schulordnung*, 1574/1618	7/2.1, p. 909	2138	17.10.1
Bishopric of Verden, *Kirchenordnung*, 1606	7/1, p. 149	2088	17.10.2
Osnabrück, *Superintendenten- und Predigerordnung*, 1610	7/1, pp. 296–297	2102	17.10.3
Oldenburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1573	7/2.1, pp. 987–988	2147	17.10.4
Oldenburg, *Bestallung* (appointment) of Superintendent Gottfried Schlüter, 1608, quoted in Sehling's apparatus	7/2.1, p. 964	2142	17.10.4
Bremen, *Einigung des geistlichen Ministeriums über die in Bremen gültige Lehre*, 1572 (Philippist)	7/2.2, p. 548	2226	17.10.5
East Frisia, *Marienhafer Kirchenordnung*, 1593	7/1, p. 684	2119	17.10.6
East Frisia, *Die Konkordaten*, 1599 (Reformed–Lutheran treaty)	7/1, p. 421	2110	17.10.6
Soest, *Artikel der Prediger*, 1 September 1590	22, p. 480	1536	17.10.7

Hesse and its neighbours

Order	Sehling	Doc	§
Hesse, *Abschied* of the general synod, 1571 (Philippist)	8, p. 355	2263	17.11.1
Hesse, *Agende*, 1574 (Philippist)	8, p. 415	2272	17.11.1
Hessen-Kassel, *Diensteid der Pfarrer in der Niedergrafschaft Katzenelnbogen*, 20 February 1598 (Philippist)	9, p. 54	2287	17.11.1
Hessen-Darmstadt, *Mandat zur Beibehaltung der Confessio Augustana*, 28 July 1617	9, p. 152	2287	17.11.1
Waldeck, *Kirchenordnung* 1556, ordination form in the revision of about 1584	9, p. 292	2300	17.11.2
Frankfurt, *Agende*, 1589	9, p. 541	2332	17.11.3
Nassau-Diez, *Revers der Kirchendiener*, [1564]	10, p. 103	177	17.11.4
Nassau-Weilburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1574/1576	10, p. 306	198	17.11.5
Ysenburg-Birstein, *Kirchenordnung*, 1588	10, p. 619	228	17.11.5

The Palatinates

Order	Sehling	Doc	§
Kurpfalz, *Kirchenordnung* of Ottheinrich, 1556	14, pp. 114–115	476	17.12.1
Kurpfalz, *Kirchendienerbestallung*, 1580	14, p. 507	505	17.12.1
Kurpfalz, *Kirchendienerbestallung*, 1586 (Reformed)	14, p. 525	509	17.12.1
Kurpfalz, *Schuldienerbestallung*, 1601 (Reformed)	14, p. 593	517	17.12.1
Upper Palatinate, *Kirchenratsinstruktion*, 3 March 1585 (Reformed)	13, pp. 328–329	420	17.12.2
Pfalz-Neuburg, *Mandat gegen die Kalvinisten*, 1564	13, p. 148	401	17.12.3
Pfalz-Neuburg, *Generalartikel*, 1576	13, pp. 171, 176	404	17.12.3, 17.17.2
Pfalz-Zweibrücken, *Bekenntnisverpflichtung der Kirchendiener*, 1564	18, pp. 328–329	982	17.12.4
Hintere Grafschaft Sponheim, *Generalartikel*, 1608	18, p. 671	1021	17.12.5

Württemberg, Hohenlohe and Swabia

Order	Sehling	Doc	§
Württemberg, *Visitationsordnung*, 1547	16, p. 155	659	17.13.1
Württemberg, *Eid der Kirchendiener*, [after 1559]	16, p. 424	685	17.13.1
Württemberg, *Mandat zur Unterzeichnung der Konkordienformel*, 1577	16, p. 445	692	17.13.2
Hohenlohe, *Kirchenordnung*, 1578	15, p. 260	574	17.13.3
Hohenlohe, *Verzeichnis* of 4 November 1581, quoted in the apparatus to the *Kirchenordnung* of 1578	15, p. 261	574	17.13.3
Hohenlohe, *Eid der gemeinsamen Kirchendiener*, 1588	15, p. 562	608	17.13.3
Hohenlohe, *Erb- und Teilungsverträge*, 1609–1615	15, p. 674	633	17.13.3

Order	Sehling	Doc	§
Schwäbisch Hall, ordination, *Kirchenordnung* 1614/15	17/1, p. 184	763	17.13.5
Wimpfen, *Eid und Pflichten der Geistlichen*, [after 1577]	17/2, p. 530	930	17.13.5
Ravensburg, *Konkordie und Kirchenordnung*, 28 January 1578, renewal of 1617	17/2, p. 500	922	17.13.5

Franconia and Regensburg

Order	Sehling	Doc	§
Brandenburg-Ansbach-Kulmbach, *Der evangelische Priestereid*, 1528	11, pp. 107, 109	264	17.14.1
Brandenburg-Ansbach-Kulmbach, *Konsistorialordnung*, 1594	11, p. 388	291	17.14.1
Regensburg, *Kirchenordnung* (of 1567?)	13, p. 453	450	17.14.3
Regensburg, *Kirchenregimentsordnung*, 1572/1588	13, pp. 494–495	452	17.14.3, 17.17.5

Strasbourg, Alsace and Transylvania

Order	Sehling	Doc	§
Strasbourg, *Examensordnung*, 1549 (under the Interim)	20/1, p. 365	1318	17.15.1
Strasbourg, *Gottesdienstordnung*, [after August 1577]	20/1, p. 512	1336	17.15.2
Strasbourg, *Kirchenordnung*, 9 April 1598	20/1, pp. 640–641	1344	17.15.2
Colmar, *Eid der Prediger*, 22 October 1575	20/2, p. 501	1408	17.15.3
Colmar, *Ablehnung des Beitritts zur Konkordienformel*, 10 May 1578 (Moderate Reformed)	20/2, p. 509	1408	17.15.3
Burzenland, *Beschlüsse des Burzenländer Kapitels zum Eid auf die Confessio Augustana*, 1573	24, p. 371	1694	17.16
Transylvanian Saxons, *Ordnung der Superintendentenwahl*, 1601	24, p. 480	1722	17.16

The laity (§17.17)

Order	Sehling	Doc	§
Hesse, *Ziegenhainer Zuchtordnung*, 1539 (Moderate Reformed)	8, p. 104	2252	17.17.1
Hesse, *Kasseler Kirchenordnung*, 1539 (Moderate Reformed)	8, p. 125	2253	17.17.1
Strasbourg, *Kirchenordnung von Johannes Marbach*, 1553	20/1, p. 396	1321	17.17.1
East Frisia (Reformed), *Microns Ordinancien* (1554), 1565	7/1, p. 607	2116	17.17.1
Schweinfurt, *Kirchenordnung*, 1543	11, p. 640	304	17.17.2
Württemberg, *Visitationsordnung*, 1557	16, p. 331	682	17.17.2
Nassau-Dillenburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1582 (Reformed)	10, p. 163	184	17.17.2
Kurpfalz, *Mandat zum Katechismusunterricht*, 1 February 1599 (Reformed)	19/2, p. 890	1175	17.17.3
Baden, *Wiedertäufermandat*, 1543, version C	16, p. 515	704	17.17.3

Order	Sehling	Doc	§
Limpurg, *Visitationsordnung*, 1611	16, p. 629	730	17.17.4
Wied, *Synodalbeschlüsse*, 5 June 1564 (Reformed)	19/1, p. 466	1094	17.17.4
Nassau-Weilburg, *Erläuterungspunkte zur Kirchenordnung*, 1609	10, p. 329	198	17.17.4
Soest, *Anweisung zu den Taufpaten*, 8 June 1583	22, p. 478	1534	17.17.4
Heilbronn, *Eid des Heilbronner Rates auf den neuen Glauben*, 18 November 1530	17/1, p. 290	771	17.17.5
Kurpfalz, *Presbyterordnung*, about 1601 (Reformed)	14, p. 598	518	17.17.5

Chapter 18. Church Fellowship Between the Traditions

This chapter covers the rules of church fellowship between the confessional traditions in the evangelical church orders of the sixteenth and early seventeenth centuries, as printed in Emil Sehling's *Die evangelischen Kirchenordnungen des XVI. Jahrhunderts* (The Evangelical Church Orders of the Sixteenth Century). It asks six questions, and three that follow from them:

- Who could **pray** with whom, and for whom?
- Who could **commune** with whom? Who was admitted to the Supper, and where might a Lutheran receive it?
- Who could **baptize** whom? Whose baptism was valid, whose children were baptized, and who could stand as godparent?
- Who could **absolve** whom?
- Who could **ordain** whom, and whose orders were accepted?
- Who could **preach** where?
- How were those of another religion **buried**, and what became of a **marriage** between spouses of unequal religion?
- What did the orders say about **going out** to the worship of another confession?
- What **agreements** did the traditions make with one another?

The other confessions the orders deal with are the Roman Catholics (in the orders' word, "papists"), the Zwinglians and Calvinists (often "Sacramentarians"), the Anabaptists, Schwenckfelders and other "sects", and, in Poland and Prussia, the Bohemian Brethren. The rules also changed with time and differed from territory to territory. Where an order is not Lutheran, its tradition is named, as everywhere in the book.

The findings are summarised in §18.1, and the method is described in §18.2. §18.3 sets out the language of fellowship. §§18.4–18.10 take the acts one by one: baptism, the Supper, absolution, ordination, preaching, prayer, burial and marriage. §18.11 covers the agreements between traditions, and §18.12 how the rules changed. §18.13 is a table by order, and §18.14 a concordance of the orders quoted.

Related chapters. Several subjects are treated more fully elsewhere and are only cited here:

- the confessional norms and oaths that defined each church, and the laity's admission to communion and as godparents: Chapter 17, §§17.4, 17.17.2, 17.17.4;
- emergency baptism and its confirmation in church: Chapter 13, §13.3.7;
- the evangelical ordination and why it was begun: Chapter 13, §§13.10, 13.10.1;
- the examination of communicants: Chapter 13, §13.17.4;
- the confessional tradition of every order: Chapter 1, §1.3, and the Polish synods, §1.9.3.

18.1 Summary of findings

18.1.1 The main findings

1. No order sets out a doctrine of church fellowship as such. The rules are given act by act, under baptism, godparents, the Supper, confession, ordination, the pulpit and burial. Where the orders speak in general terms, they speak of "having fellowship" (*gemeinschaft haben*) with heretics and sects, and they forbid it:

- Kurland in 1570 forbade fellowship with papists, Jesuits, Calvinists, Sacramentarians, Anabaptists and others, and forbade inviting them to stand as godparents, to feasts or to christenings (§18.3).
- Hohenlohe in 1579 forbade its ministers to have fellowship with Jews and with obstinate papist priests.
- Pfalz-Zweibrücken in 1564 forbade fellowship and the exchange of letters with any "Sacramentarian fanatic".
- The visitors of Württemberg and of the many orders that copied its visitation order asked who "harboured, lodged or had fellowship with" Anabaptists, Schwenckfelders and Sacramentarians.

The warrant is 2 John 10–11 and Titus 3:10: not to receive such a man into the house, nor greet him.

2. Baptism crossed every line, and no order rebaptizes.

- Baptism given in the papacy is "a right and complete baptism", because it rests on Christ's word and not on the priest (Braunschweig-Wolfenbüttel 1569, Oldenburg 1573).
- The baptism of a midwife stands, "though the Calvinists reject" it (Wolfstein 1574).

- Honterus's Transylvanian order of 1543 adds the baptism of laymen, of heathen and of heretics in the faith of the Trinity, and forbids the rebaptism of the Orthodox Romanians.

The limits lay elsewhere (§18.4.2):

- Thorn refused baptism to papists who sought it only for rich Lutheran godparents and then had the child anointed by their own priests, unless they would use the Lutheran ministry in everything.
- The Transylvanian synod of Mediasch (1578) sent the children of Gypsies and Romanians back to their own congregations, "since they are not of our religion".

3. Godparents were the most disputed point (§18.4.3). The orders give three answers.

- **Exclude** papists, Calvinists and all of another religion: Ernestine Saxony 1542, Magdeburg 1554, the Bremen preachers in 1561, Regensburg 1567, Kurland 1570, Soest 1590, and the Wild- and Rhinegraviate 1597 and 1603. At Landau in 1582 the pastor refused a Calvinist godmother. Bremen's reasons were that papists "cannot pray" and that admitting one is a false witness that he is a member of the church.
- **Admit with discretion**, because godparenthood is a human ordinance and a papist who stands at a Lutheran font "acknowledgeth our holy baptism to be Christian and right". This was the rule of Hesse 1556 (Moderate Reformed), of Electoral Saxony 1580 and the orders that copied it, of Pfalz-Neuburg 1576, and of the Schwäbisch Hall draft of 1614.
- **Both religions** freely admitted: Soest 1583 (§17.17.4).

On the reverse question the orders agree: no Lutheran is to stand at a papist baptism, since that confirms its "sorcerous ceremonies" (Electoral Saxony 1580, Pfalz-Neuburg 1576). At Strasbourg in 1601 the magistrate declined to bar Calvinists from the font.

4. The Supper was closed to those of another confession (§18.5.1).

- Reutlingen (c. 1531) bars papists and those who deny the presence of Christ's body and blood.
- Waldeck 1556 bars those of papist, Anabaptist and Sacramentarian doctrine until they revoke it.
- Prussia 1568 refuses absolution and the sacrament to those who defend the errors of the papists, Sacramentarians and Anabaptists.

Strangers were heard on their faith before the seniors (Hesse 1574 and its copies). To commune with a church was to belong to it: "whatever man communicateth … with the Lutherans, Zwinglians, papists, Anabaptists etc., he is reckoned for one of them" (Wild- and Rhinegraviate 1597).

5. Yet the Lutherans gave the sacrament across the papal line (§18.5.3).

- From 1528 the Brandenburg-Nürnberg orders ministered to people from Catholic parishes whose pastors refused them the sacraments "against the word of God". So did Prussia 1568, Wolfstein 1574 and Schwäbisch Hall, by a chapter decree of 1564 repeated in 1570 and 1615.
- Pfalz-Neuburg in 1576 let its pastors give the Supper to sick Calvinists who attended Lutheran sermons, "if the lordship can suffer it".

6. Going out to another church (*Auslaufen*) was forbidden on all sides, and practised on all sides (§18.5.4).

- **Evangelical bans:** Strasbourg forbade going out to hear Mass in 1531, and sermons and sacraments in "foreign lordships" in 1597, this time against the Reformed. Frankfurt in 1542 forbade running to Masses in the villages. Leiningen in 1566 forbade the Supper or baptism outside one's own parish.
- **Reformed bans:** Nassau-Diez (1585) had foreign pastors who gave the Supper arrested. Kurpfalz (1595) fought its people's running to the neighbouring "Lutheran and Ubiquitist" pastors. Hanau (1599/1602), Ysenburg (1598), Homburg (1605) and Sayn (1606, 1619) issued bans of their own.
- **A Catholic council:** Colmar tried in 1554 to stop its burghers from going to services in Lutheran Horburg.

In practice the bans did not hold. In 1606 the Lutheran pastor of Lambrechtsneukirchen had 1,765 communicants, of whom 694 came from the Reformed Upper Palatinate. Sehling's editor reports that when the Lutheran Elector of the Palatinate forbade his Calvinists in 1578 to go to the Reformed Supper, Beza and Ursinus approved their receiving it at Lutheran altars.

7. Absolution came only from a called minister, and normally from one's own (§18.6).

- **Not from monks or priests.** Bugenhagen's Hamburg order of 1529 gave confession to those who preach. The Upper German catechisms called the priests' absolution "a deceit" (Capito's Strasbourg catechism, Sam's Ulm catechism).
- **Not for defenders of error.** Prussia 1568 refused it to them.
- **From one's own pastor.** Prussia 1568 and Soest 1590 tied confession to the parish. Lippe 1571 complained of excommunicates who went to another parish and "stole" the absolution there.
- **Within one city, from any minister.** Regensburg 1572 let people choose their confessor from the whole ministry, "since they all have one office and equal power".

8. Orders received from the Roman bishops were accepted (§18.7).

- The *Wittenberg Reformation* of 1545 would have taken ordination from bishops who accepted right doctrine (§13.10.1).
- The orders ordain those "not ordained" (Hoya 1581), and do not ordain again one ordained elsewhere (Brunswick 1571, Strasbourg 1598).
- Hannover in 1536 insisted that its preachers had been ordained in the very church that cast them out.
- Buxtehude in 1552 and Hamburg in 1556 gave up the bishops' consecration as given "only for the godless service", and ordained with prayer and the laying on of hands.

There are two exceptions on the Lutheran side and one on the Catholic:

- **Pfalz-Neuburg 1576** re-ordained priests coming from the papacy "in the stead of a recantation".
- **Magdeburg 1554** would not hold for Christians those who took orders or prebends from papists.
- **The Count Palatine** made Amberg dismiss a preacher in 1539, because he had been ordained by Luther and not by a bishop.

9. No one preached without a call, and no stranger entered a pulpit without the superintendent or the ministry (§18.8).

- **Hedge preachers** were forbidden everywhere.
- **Disputes:** Wolfstein forbade its pastors to dispute with foreign Calvinist or papist pastors.
- **Mixed cities and territories** bound their preachers not to revile the other religion: the Augsburg preacher's oath of 1591, the Upper Palatinate's *mandatum de non calumniando* (mandate against calumny) of 1598, and the Reformed Kurpfalz mandate against condemnations of 1584.

10. Prayer (§18.9).

- **No joint worship** with another confession is provided for anywhere outside Poland. But at Wimpfen in 1568 the hearers of each religion might attend the other's sermon in silence. And Pfalz-Neuburg in 1576 let its people go with a Catholic wedding party as far as the church door.
- **For and against.** The orders pray for heretics and the erring (Heilbronn 1530, Ulm 1531, the Ansbach *Auctuarium* of 1548), and against them (Regensburg 1567, Kurland 1570, Pfalz-Zweibrücken 1565).
- **Could papists pray?** The Bremen preachers held that a papist's prayer is "nothing but sin and curse". The Hessian visitors of 1556 held that papists "confess one faith with us, and are separated from us only in certain abuses".

11. Burial and marriage (§18.10).

- **Burial.** Obstinate papists and heretics were refused the churchyard (Magdeburg 1554, Hoya 1581, Mansfeld 1580). Magdeburg pointed out that the papists refused it to "us evangelicals".
- **Marriage.** A marriage was not to be broken because one spouse was of "unequal religion" (Lauenburg 1585, after 1 Corinthians 7).

12. Agreements were made between traditions (§18.11).

- **The Wittenberg Concord (1536)** joined the Saxon and Upper German churches. The Reformed Kurpfalz of 1584 recalled that its makers "acknowledged one another as brothers".
- **Prussia, 1549.** Duke Albrecht admitted the Bohemian Brethren after examining their confession, judging their ceremonies indifferent.
- **Sandomierz, 1570.** The Consensus of Sandomierz and the Posen articles let Lutheran, Reformed and Brethren ministers preach and give the sacraments in each other's churches. The synods renewed this until 1595.

- **Rappoltstein, 1561.** The Lutheran congregation demanded that the Reformed French congregation sign the Augsburg Confession, take its ceremonies and own it as "the head". Their lord let each keep its own.

18.1.2 Who could do what with whom

The table gives the rule most orders follow, with the main exceptions. The last column is the Polish union of 1570.

Act	Roman Catholics	Zwinglians, Calvinists	Anabaptists and sects	Another Lutheran parish	Poland (Sandomierz)
Baptism given by them	Valid; never repeated (§18.4.1)	Not repeated in any order; lay baptism kept against them	Their rebaptism rejected	—	Exorcism to be dropped (§18.11.3)
Their children baptized	Yes; Thorn refused papists who used the font only for gifts	Yes (Bremen 1561)	Children of returning Anabaptists to be baptized	With one's own pastor's consent (Leiningen 1566)	—
As godparents	Disputed: excluded, or admitted if not blasphemers (§18.4.3)	Disputed: excluded (Bremen 1561, Landau 1582, Soest 1590), or admitted if not blasphemers (Electoral Saxony 1580); Strasbourg 1601 would not bar them	Excluded	—	—
Lutherans as their godparents	Not to stand at a papist baptism	—	—	—	—
Supper	Refused to papists; given to the parishioners of papist pastors who refuse them the right use (§18.5.3)	Refused; given to sick Calvinists in Pfalz-Neuburg 1576	Refused	Only with cause or one's pastor's consent (§18.5.2)	Given, with the other pastor's testimony (§18.11.3)
Going to their worship	Forbidden (§18.5.4); to a wedding, only to the church door (§18.9.2)	Forbidden on both sides	Forbidden; conventicles banned	Forbidden without leave	Encouraged
Absolution	Their absolution rejected; ours refused to defenders of error (§18.6)	Refused to defenders of error	Refused	From one's own pastor; at Regensburg from any minister of the city	The other side's excommunicates not admitted to the Supper
Orders	Accepted (one exception: Pfalz-Neuburg 1576); taking papist orders condemned	Ordinand to renounce Calvin's doctrine of the Supper (Pfalz-Zweibrücken 1567)	—	Accepted, with the certificate	A minister of either confession might be called

Act	Roman Catholics	Zwinglians, Calvinists	Anabaptists and sects	Another Lutheran parish	Poland (Sandomierz)
	(Magdeburg 1554) (§18.7)				
Pulpit	Closed; no disputes with their pastors; no reviling in mixed towns (§18.8)	Closed; no disputes; Reformed rulers forbade condemnations	Hedge preachers banned	Only with the superintendent's or the ministry's leave	Open to each other's ministers
Prayer	Prayed for and against; whether they can pray disputed (§18.9)	Prayed for and against	Prayed for and against	—	Joint synods; common days of fasting and prayer (Thorn 1595)
Burial	Obstinate papists refused the churchyard (§18.10)	Unrepentant heretics refused (Hoya 1581, Mansfeld 1580)	Unrepentant heretics refused	—	—
Marriage	Not dissolved for unequal religion (Lauenburg 1585)	Not dissolved	Desertion by an Anabaptist frees the other spouse	—	—

18.2 Scope, sources and method

18.2.1 What was searched

The whole of `eko.db` was searched for the names of the other confessions, in German and Latin and with their OCR variants: the words for papist, in the papacy and Roman; for Zwinglian, Calvinist, Sacramentarian, Sacramentarian fanatic and Ubiquitist; for Anabaptists, Schwenckfelders, sects, factions and heretics; for the Picards, the Bohemian Brethren, the Waldensians and the Wallachians; and for "strange religion" and "of both religions".

These were then searched near the words for each act:

- **baptism and godparents:** baptism, godparent, sponsor;
- **the Supper:** sacrament, supper, communion, to admit;
- **confession:** confession, absolution;
- **ordination:** to ordain, consecration, certificate of ordination;
- **preaching:** to preach, pulpit, hedge preacher;
- **prayer and fellowship:** prayer, to pray for, fellowship, to avoid;
- **burial and marriage:** to bury, churchyard, marriage.

Further searches covered:

- strangers' parishioners and strangers at communion;
- going out to other churches;
- concords and unions, among them the Consensus of Sandomierz;
- shared churches and towns of two religions.

Every hit was read in context and sorted by whether it was the text of an order, Sehling's introduction or a footnote.

18.2.2 Cautions

- **Lists are not rules.** Many orders list papists, Zwinglians, Anabaptists and others in a condemnation, a visitation question or a list of forbidden books. These show who the church held to be outside it, but they are not rules of fellowship. They are cited only where the order draws a consequence for one of the acts.
- **"Fellowship" is the orders' own word.** The orders use *gemeinschaft* (fellowship) in two senses: the Christian fellowship of the church, and dealings with heretics. Neither is the modern technical term "church fellowship". The chapter keeps their words.
- **Editors' introductions.** Several statements are found only in Sehling's introductions and footnotes, which summarise archival sources. These include the Prussian reception of the Bohemian Brethren, the Reformed theologians' opinion on communing at Lutheran altars, and the communicant figures at Lambrechtsneukirchen. They are marked as the editors' accounts.
- **Record headings.** As elsewhere, a database record may hold several orders. So document 1844 is headed with Danzig's order of 1557, but its p. 230 is the Thorn order of after 1560. Each order is named here from Sehling's running head and the inventory of Chapter 1.
- **Traditions.** The Upper Palatinate, Nassau-Dillenburg and Diez, Hanau, Ysenburg, Wied, Moers, Sayn after 1605, Homburg after 1605 and Kurpfalz after 1583 were Reformed. So were the French congregations of Rappoltstein and Frankfurt. Hesse under Philip was Moderate Reformed and Philippist afterwards. The early orders of Strasbourg and Ulm are Moderate Reformed. The Polish synods belong to the Sandomierz consensus. Their rules are given beside the Lutheran ones, labelled, because they show the same questions from the other side.

18.3 The language of fellowship

Why the evangelicals had parted from Rome. The Hannover order of 1536 answers the charge that the evangelicals had left the church. They did not leave it over the papists' evil life, "so that we would therefore have no fellowship with them in Christian things", but over their doctrine; and it was the papists who cast them out with the ban. **Hannover, *Kirchenordnung*, 1536** (Sehling 6/2, p. 999):

We have also not withdrawn or separated ourselves from the papists for the sake of their evil life, so that we would therefore have no fellowship with them in Christian things; but their doctrine we will not accept, and they thrust us from them with their ban.

No fellowship with the sects. The fullest list is Kurland's church reformation of 1570. It names every party then known and draws the practical consequence: no invitation to stand as godparent, to a feast or a christening, or to any other "Christian gathering". **Kurland, *Kurländische Kirchenreformation*, 1570** (Sehling 5, p. 64):

Sixthly and lastly. The godly Christians shall avoid all offence, of doctrine and of life, and all hindrance of the right service of God, by whatsoever name they may be called; that a man be free from all corruptions and have no fellowship with the Epicureans, Pelagians, Osiandrists, papists, Jesuits, enthusiasts, Anabaptists, Calvinists, Sacramentarians, and all other fanatics, sects and heretics; and that he bid or invite them to no standing as godparent, to no feasts and christenings, nor to other Christian gatherings.

The ministers first. Hohenlohe's chapter and visitation order of 1579 lays the rule on the clergy. **Hohenlohe, *Kapitels- und Visitationsordnung*, 1579** (Sehling 15, p. 380):

10. Also no minister of the church shall have fellowship with unbelieving and unchristian people, such as Jews, obstinate papist priests, and vicious and ill-instructed persons, or have dealings with them; since thereby our Christian religion is not a little belittled, they are strengthened, and godly Christians are offended.

Pfalz-Zweibrücken's mandate against the Calvinists of 1564 forbids its ministers to "have fellowship with any Sacramentarian fanatic, nor exchange writings with them", without leave from the duke or his councillors and the superintendents. **Pfalz-Zweibrücken, *Mandat gegen die Calvinisten*, 1564** (Sehling 18, p. 316):

and also, as often as need requireth, refute and confute at length out of God's word the Zwinglian and Calvinist condemned opinion, and all other harmful sects; and have fellowship with no Sacramentarian fanatic, nor exchange writings with them, unless it be done upon sufficient previous report, with the foreknowledge and leave of us, or of our governor and councillors and certain superintendents.

The visitation question. Württemberg's visitation order for the superintendents asked of every parish whether anyone there "harboured, lodged or had fellowship" with the sectaries. **Württemberg, *Visitationsordnung für die Superintendenten*, 1559** (Sehling 16, p. 387):

Item, whether anyone be infected with Anabaptism, the Schwenckfelders, the Sacramentarians and other sects, or harbour, lodge or have fellowship with such fanatics.

The same question was taken into the Braunschweig-Wolfenbüttel order of 1569 (Sehling 6/1, p. 196), Hohenlohe's visitation of 1571 (Sehling 15, p. 164) and Limpurg's visitation order of 1611 (Sehling 16, p. 626). The Transylvanian Saxons asked it of the Arians and Anabaptists in 1577 (Sehling 24, p. 422). Their common order of 1578 forbade a pastor to have "fellowship" with the open enemies of God and his church, "or lodge them" (Sehling 24, p. 434).

The warrant: 2 John and Titus 3. Mansfeld's agenda of 1580 gives the texts on which the rule rests. **Mansfeld, *Kirchen-agenda für die prediger der grafschaft Mansfeld*, 1580** (Sehling 2, p. 247):

Secondly, St John and St Paul say, in the second of John and to Titus in the third chapter, that one shall avoid the people who have departed from the pure, wholesome doctrine and become heretics and false teachers, or their adherents and fellows, when they have been admonished to desist therefrom; and shall not receive them into the house, nor greet them at all, that one make not himself partaker of their sins.

Wolfstein's instruction of 1574 quotes 2 John 10–11 in Latin for the same purpose (§18.8.3). The Polish general synod of Kraków in 1573 used the same words of the Arian Anabaptists, who had gone out from the Reformed churches of Poland. **Synod of Kraków, 1573** (Sandomierz consensus; Sehling 4, pp. 261–262):

Since the Arian Anabaptists, who went out from us, abide not in the doctrine of Christ and the faith of the true God, the Father and the Son with the Holy Ghost, and so have not God, and, having been very often admonished by us already in conferences and writings, remain obstinately in their error: let us have no further dealings with them (so long as they defend their opinion), let us admit no disputations of theirs, but let us avoid them and their blasphemous books according to the precept of the Holy Ghost,

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18.4 Baptism

18.4.1 Baptism given by others

Baptism in the papacy. No order in the corpus repeats a baptism given by a Roman priest. Chemnitz's instruction in the Braunschweig-Wolfenbüttel order of 1569 states the ground: the "substantials of baptism" remained in the papacy, and baptism rests on Christ's word, not on the priest. The passage was taken word for word into Oldenburg's order of 1573 (Sehling 7/2.1, p. 1045). **Wolfenbüttel, *Kirchenordnung*, 1569** (Sehling 6/1, p. 124):

Herewith also must instruction be given that, although in the papacy many superstitions crept in, yet because the substantials of baptism remained, those who were baptized in the papacy have a right and complete baptism; for the same standeth and resteth not on the priest's unworthiness or misuse, but on the word of the Lord Christ, Eph. 5 [26].

Baptism by laymen, heathen and heretics. Honterus's *Reformationsbüchlein* for the Transylvanian Saxons (1543) goes furthest. It keeps the midwife's emergency baptism and cites the canons: baptism given by a layman, a heathen or a heretic "in the faith of the Holy Trinity" is not to be repeated. Then it applies the rule to the Orthodox Romanians, whose baptism the Saxon churches also recognised. **Transylvanian Saxons, Honterus, *Reformationsbüchlein*, 1543, German version** (Sehling 24, p. 193):

But the children who in time of need are wisely and rightly baptized by the midwife, according to the mind of all right teachers of the church, we will in no wise let be baptized again a second time; for the sacraments can neither gain nor lose anything through the quality or property of the person of the minister. For the canons also command that the baptism which is done by a layman or a heathen shall not be done again a second time; and likewise also the baptism which is done by heretics and evildoers in the faith of the Holy Trinity. Item, to baptize again a heretic who hath received the sign of the Holy Trinity according to Christian doctrine is altogether sin; or to baptize again a Christian is an unspeakable sin. Therefore neither the children nor the Wallachians, once rightly baptized, shall be baptized again.

The midwife's baptism against the Calvinists. The Lutheran orders kept emergency baptism by any Christian (§13.3.7). The Reformed rejected it and kept baptism for the called minister alone:

- Hesse's Kassel order of 1539 (Moderate Reformed; Sehling 8, p. 119, editor's note);
- the Kurpfalz order of 1563 (Reformed; Sehling 14, p. 337, editor's note);
- the Moers order of 1581 (Reformed; Sehling 22, p. 190, editor's note).

Wolfstein's instruction of 1574 names the difference. **Wolfstein, *Christliche Instructio* of Thomas Stieber, 1574** (Sehling 13, p. 580):

Forasmuch as hitherto there hath been and been kept in the Christian church a laudable and well-grounded order, that all Christian persons, not only men but also women, especially the midwives (since they also are heirs together of the grace of God, as Peter teacheth [1 Pet. 3:7], and necessity is not subject to the common rule), have baptized the little children in time of need in the absence of the men, which hath been called a hasty or sudden baptism: so shall the same not be done away, but remain and be kept; and it shall not mislead us, though the Calvinists, out of great untimely cleverness, reject such hasty baptism, as though it were wrong.

The Transylvanian synod of Mediasch (1578) kept the midwives' baptism too, but told them not to baptize "rashly", and to send for the minister whenever they could (Sehling 24, p. 427).

Exorcism as a mark of confession. The exorcism in the baptismal rite became a sign of confession. Henneberg kept it in 1582 so that "the Zwinglians and Calvinists be not gratified or humoured in the least" (Sehling 2, p. 305). Soest's order of 1609 left it free. But if the Sacramentarians should try to bring in their fanaticism "by abolishing the exorcism", the preachers were to defend and use it (Sehling 22, p. 492). The Polish churches of the Sandomierz consensus took the opposite course: the Posen articles of 1570 listed exorcism among the "papistical" rites to be done away (Sehling 4, p. 259).

18.4.2 The children of others

The orders baptized the children of all who asked, with two exceptions.

Papists who used the font only for gifts. At Thorn the papists, who otherwise "revile and avoid our whole office of preaching", sought Lutheran baptism for the rich gifts of Lutheran godparents. Afterwards they had the child anointed by their own priests. They were refused, unless they promised to use the Lutheran ministry "in all points". **Thorn, *Kirchenordnung*, after 1560** (Sehling 4, p. 230):

And forasmuch as many papists here otherwise revile and avoid our whole office of preaching, and only sometimes desire baptism for their children, out of greed, that they may have godparents of our side for the rich christening gift, but afterwards let the baptized children be oiled and smeared by the priests of their side: baptism shall not be given them, unless they promise to use our preaching office in all points, and to forsake the papist idolatry; lest we serve their greed with holy baptism and otherwise let the preaching office be reviled by them,

The same order would not admit "to baptism or any Christian work" anyone who stayed away from the Supper for long "out of Sacramentarian and Schwenckfeldian or otherwise profane opinion". Here baptism means standing at the font (Sehling 4, p. 230).

Children of another people. The Transylvanian synod of Mediasch in 1578 sent the children of the Gypsies and of the Orthodox Romanians back to their own congregations. **Mediasch synod, 1578** (Sehling 24, p. 427):

XXI. Let the infants of the Gypsies and the Wallachians be sent back to their own congregations. Nor let them be baptized in our churches, since they are not of our religion, lest they expose it to mockery.

The ground of the refusal is the parents' religion, not the validity of the baptism. Honterus's order of 1543 had recognised the Romanians' baptism (§18.4.1).

Sacramentarian parents. The Bremen preachers in 1561 would baptize the children of Sacramentarians "as we have said of the illegitimate" ones, but not with Sacramentarian godparents (§18.4.3). If such parents carried the child out unbaptized rather than give up their godparents, the preachers would report it to the council, as keeper of discipline (Sehling 7/2.2, p. 527).

Anabaptists who returned. Württemberg's visitation order of 1557 required an Anabaptist who returned to have his children baptized and to receive the Supper "with other Christians in his parish church" (Sehling 16, p. 335).

18.4.3 Godparents of another confession

The godparent was the one lay share in the rites. Whether a papist or a Calvinist could stand at a Lutheran font is the fellowship question the orders discuss most. The cases already set out in §17.17.4 are not repeated here: Limpurg 1611, Wied 1564 (Reformed), Nassau-Weilburg 1609 and Soest 1583.

Excluded. Ernestine Saxony's consistory constitution of 1542 admitted no godparent who was not "of our true and Christian religion" (Sehling 1, p. 202). Magdeburg's pastors in 1554 barred "obstinate, blaspheming papists" from both the sacrament and the font (Sehling 2, p. 451). The Regensburg order gives the reason: the godparent stands at the font "as a true member of the Christian church", who prays with the congregation. **Regensburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1567(?), appendix** (Sehling 13, p. 489):

[Appendix.] That persons related to the papists and other sects may not be admitted as godparents at baptism. The godparent standeth there at the baptism before the others, not only as a witness, but also as a true member of the Christian church, who can and shall pray to God with [the church], and help to bring up the child also in the true Christian faith.

The Bremen preachers, answering the city's questions in 1561, gave the longest argument. Papists cannot pray, cannot bear witness, and cannot teach the catechism. A minister who admits one gives "a false witness against the eighth commandment", acknowledging a papist as a member of the church and of its fellowship. **Bremen, *Stellungnahme der Prediger zu den Anfragen der Wittheit*, 1561** (Sehling 7/2.2, pp. 526–527):

Item, where the godparents also are papist, we know in no wise to admit them to holy baptism, and that for these unavoidable reasons. First, because the godparents are asked for prayer's sake, the papists cannot pray; for since they are without faith in Christ, their prayer is nothing but mere sin and curse. […] Lastly, the ministers of the church also sin grievously who by admitting the papists do not distinguish them from the Christians, strengthen them in their error, and offend other Christians, so that they think one doctrine is as good as the other; and [such a minister] giveth a false witness against the eighth commandment, in that he publicly acknowledgeth a papist as a member of the church and in its fellowship, though he belongeth not therein, and himself believeth not what he speaketh for the child with the Holy Trinity.

The print reads *umbs gelts willen*, "for money's sake". The sense, and the two reasons that follow ("for the witness of baptism", "for instruction in the catechism"), require "for prayer's sake". The preachers would no more suffer Sacramentarian godparents "than the papist, for the reasons alleged above" (Sehling 7/2.2, p. 527).

Kurland in 1570 (§18.3) and Soest in 1590 excluded the godparents of every other religion. **Soest, *Artikel der Prediger*, 1 September 1590** (Sehling 22, p. 480):

3. Papists, Calvinists and all others, be they of spiritual or temporal estate, who are contrary to our religion, shall not be suffered or admitted to stand as godparents at baptism.

To commune with a church is to belong to it. The Wild- and Rhinegraviate's order for godparents of 1597 gives fourteen reasons against erring godparents. One rests on what communion means: whoever takes part in another body's rite is reckoned to it. **Wild- and Rhinegraviate, *Patenordnung*, 1597** (Sehling 19/2, p. 574):

Moreover this is also the common opinion of all teachers and hearers: for whoever letteth himself be circumcised by the Jews and helpeth devoutly to perform the circumcision among them, him everyone holdeth for a Jew; but whichever Jew letteth himself be baptized, he becometh or is become a Christian, and is held for one. Whatever man communicateth, or helpeth to communicate, with the Lutherans, Zwinglians, papists, Anabaptists etc., he is reckoned for one of them.

The church order of the same county (after 1603) asks the parents and pastors to see that "erring people, who condemn our doctrine and religion and will not be converted" are not taken as godparents (Sehling 19/2, p. 605).

Admitted with discretion. The Hessian visitation of April 1556 took the opposite view. Sehling's editor quotes its article on the "papists" in a note to the *Abschied* (recess) of the first general synod. **Hesse, visitation article of 1556, quoted in the editor's note to the *Abschied der ersten Generalsynode*, Marburg, 1568** (Moderate Reformed; the *Abschied* Philippist; Sehling 8, p. 349):

Since the same also confess one faith with us, and are separated from us only in certain abuses: where they be asked by ours to be godparents, and, being questioned on the common and chief articles of our Christian faith, give a fitting answer, they shall be admitted to stand as godparents.

The question came back to the general synod of 1568. An evangelical had asked the cathedral provost of Mainz to stand as godfather, and the superintendent at Darmstadt had refused him, "although he had offered to make the confession of his faith, had it been desired". The synod had the superintendents draw up an opinion for the princes (Sehling 8, pp. 349–350, with the editor's notes).

The Electoral Saxon order of 1580 made the milder rule the norm for a large family of orders. Its reasons are pastoral. To drive a papist from the font embitters him. Godparenthood is a human ordinance, not God's command. A papist who stands at a Lutheran font "acknowledgeth in deed our holy baptism to be Christian and right". The reverse is not allowed: no Lutheran is to stand at a papist baptism. **Electoral Saxony, *Kirchenordnung* of Elector August, 1580** (Sehling 1, pp. 432–433):

Likewise, since it also happeneth that certain persons who are still at this time addicted in many points to the superstition of the papists, when they are asked to be godparents, are driven away from holy baptism, whereby they are so much the more embittered against the pure doctrine of the holy gospel; whereas, when they are admitted, there followeth thereby, through the working of God the Holy Ghost, the conversion not only of themselves but also of more others who are led astray: therefore, since the ordinance of godparents is not a divine command, but ordained by men for good and weighty reasons, the pastors and ministers of the church shall in such case deal reasonably and prudently, and not hastily keep from holy baptism anyone who is not an open blasphemer of God and his holy word, even though he could not yet at this time find himself [right] in one or more articles; but shall remember Christ's saying, where he saith, *He that is not against us is with us*; and for the first time be content with this, that such a person by his presence acknowledgeth in deed our holy baptism to be Christian and right. On the other hand, it is to be counselled to none related to our religion that he stand at a papist baptism, and thereby confirm their papist abomination which they practise at holy baptism. Nevertheless they shall not omit withal to take such persons in hand with all gentleness on account of their error, to instruct them, to warn and dissuade them therefrom, and so keep the degrees of admonition.

The order extends the same patience to the Sacramentarians who are "imprisoned in their consciences" but do not blaspheme. It gives the theological ground: a child is baptized on Christ's command, not on the godparents' faith. **Electoral Saxony, *Kirchenordnung* of Elector August, 1580** (Sehling 1, p. 433):

Fourthly, it is also the same case with the other misled, poor, erring people who do not believe rightly of the holy sacrament, and yet do not sin wilfully nor blaspheme, but only still lie captive in their consciences: they also shall not be kept from holy baptism, but the degrees of admonition shall be undertaken with them as with the others; and, so far as possible, they, as also the foreign and native papists, shall be brought to our true religion, and not be kept therefrom by disorderly dealing. For the children are not baptized upon the godparents' faith, in which manner baptism would be uncertain, but upon the command and the word of Christ. Therefore the unbelief of the godparents in their hearts taketh nothing from the children who are to be baptized as to the power of holy baptism, which standeth alone on the command and ordinance of Christ, and bringeth with it, according to his promise, what is comprised in his word.

The Saxon text was taken into:

- Hohenlohe's church and school orders of 1582, in their consistory order, on Jakob Andreae's advice (Sehling 15, pp. 474–476);
- Sayn's church order of 1590 (Sehling 19/1, p. 414);
- Nassau-Weilburg's order of 1576, and its explanatory points of 1609 (Sehling 10, p. 329; §17.17.4).

Pfalz-Neuburg's general articles of 1576 reach the same rule on their own. They also draw the line that runs through all these orders: a papist at a Lutheran font confirms the Lutheran sacrament, and a Lutheran at a papist font confirms the papist one. **Pfalz-Neuburg, *Generalartikel*, 1576** (Sehling 13, p. 188):

In all which it is much safer to do too little than too much, since God alone knoweth the hearts of men; and there is a great difference when papists are admitted as godparents at our baptism, by which act they confirm our sacrament, and when some of our churches let themselves be used as godparents at a papist baptism, who by their presence confirm the papist sorcerous ceremonies, from which every Christian shall guard himself.

Schwäbisch Hall's draft of 1614 distinguished two kinds of papist. It cites Felix Bidembach's *Consilia theologica* (Theological counsels). The passage was struck out and is missing from the order of 1615. **Schwäbisch Hall, *Kirchenordnung* 1543/1615, draft of 1614** (Sehling 17/1, p. 123, apparatus):

But here it is asked whether one may let papist godparents also stand at our baptism; let the ninth consilium of the second decade of the *Consilia theologica* of D. Felix Bidembach be read. Thereupon it is to be known that one shall indeed not admit gross, godless, ignorant and evil, venomous papists, who are our persecutors and blasphemers; but good-hearted papists, and such as are not ill affected toward our religion, one shall admit to stand as godparents; for otherwise it is not to be expected that they would present themselves at our baptism.

Calvinist godparents at Strasbourg. In 1601 the Strasbourg church convent asked the magistrate what to do with "those in Calvinism" who were asked to be godparents. Such people either could not answer the questions to the godparents for conscience' sake, or stood silent and said neither yea nor nay. The magistrate told the preachers to keep to the church order, which, as the editor notes, had not limited godparents to the Augsburg Confession. **Strasbourg, *Stellungnahme des Magistrats zur Anfrage des Kirchenkonvents wegen der reformierten Taufpaten*, 28 March 1601** (Sehling 20/1, p. 700):

In the year 1601, on the 28th of March, there appeared, on behalf of an honourable church convent, Doctor Pappus, Master Pancratius Kefelius, Master Bartholomaeus Nasserus and certain other preachers, before the council and the Twenty-one, desiring to know how they should behave toward those in Calvinism when the same were asked to be godparents; seeing that, when the same are asked to be godparents, they either could not answer for their conscience' sake, or, if they should answer, keep altogether silent and say neither yea nor nay; […] It was commanded them to abide by the church order, as it is ordained therein concerning holy baptism.

18.5 The Lord's Supper

18.5.1 Closed to those of another confession

Every order that names the other confessions at the altar closes it to them. The orders give two grounds:

- **Doctrine.** The Supper is for those who believe the words of institution. One who denies the presence of Christ's body and blood cannot discern the body.
- **The minister's conscience.** A minister who admits those who defend error makes himself "partaker of other men's sins" (1 Timothy 5:22), and casts the pearl before swine (Matthew 7:6).

Reutlingen's order bars papists, strangers and those who deny the presence in one list. **Reutlingen, *Kirchenordnung*, c. 1531** (Sehling 17/2, p. 43):

Therefore the ministers shall diligently take heed that this sacrament of the body and blood be given to no one who is still contrary to the gospel, as the papists and unchristian people; likewise also to no stranger or unknown person; item, to the children and those who are by nature foolish and not in their right mind, who cannot discern the body of Christ; moreover to those who deny the presence of the body and blood of Christ and believe not this word; likewise also to none who is held fast in open shame and vice, and hath not yet given himself to amendment, nor will.

Waldeck's order of 1556 names the parties and sets the condition of return: a revocation of the error. **Waldeck, *Kirchenordnung*, 1556** (Sehling 9, p. 250):

The pastors also, as faithful stewards of the divine mysteries and sacraments, shall not set the noble pearl before the swine, nor the holy thing before the dogs [Matt. 7:6]. Therefore, if any man be of papist, Anabaptist, Sacramentarian or otherwise sectarian, erring doctrine, which agreeth not with our church's confession, or be given to offensive sins and vices, he shall not be admitted to the holy table of the Lord Christ, unless he revoke his erring doctrine, put away the offensive life, and let sure tokens of true repentance be seen in him.

Prussia's church order of 1568 gives the minister's side of the rule. Confession is kept so that the preacher may "know to whom he giveth the most worthy sacrament". **Prussia, *Kirchenordnung und ceremonien*, 1568** (Sehling 4, pp. 76–77):

but first, that the preacher may proceed rightly, separate the good from the evil (Jer. 15), and know to whom he giveth the most worthy sacrament; lest he make himself partaker of other men's sins (1 Tim. 5, Ezek. 3) and cast the pearl before the swine (Matt. 7), if he absolve and let come those who hold nothing of God's word and defend false, horrible errors, as the papists, the Sacramentarian fanatics, the Anabaptists and other sects like them, […] Such shall one turn away until their amendment and right, true repentance, and not give them the sacrament, since they would yet receive it to their judgment and ruin.

The rule is the same elsewhere:

- **Magdeburg 1554.** The pastors' articles admit neither to the sacrament nor to the font "obstinate, blaspheming papists who will not be converted" (Sehling 2, p. 451).
- **Rostock 1557.** The visitors' instruction tells the preachers to turn away from the Supper and from baptism those whom they can convict openly of blasphemy, "as those who hold stubbornly to the papist idolatries and revile our religion as heresy or sects" (Sehling 5, p. 283).
- **Württemberg 1557 and Nassau-Dillenburg 1582.** Württemberg visits privately those who keep from the Supper out of Zwinglian or other opinion. Reformed Nassau-Dillenburg admits only those who have confessed "the Reformed doctrine", strangers included (§17.17.2).

Two limits run through these rules:

- **Defenders, not the erring.** The orders exclude those who "defend" error, the "obstinate" and the "blasphemers". The misled and the weak are taught, not turned away (Electoral Saxony 1580, §18.4.3; Pfalz-Neuburg 1576, §18.5.3).
- **Communion makes a man a member.** Whoever communicates "with the Lutherans, Zwinglians, papists, Anabaptists etc." is reckoned one of them (Wild- and Rhinegraviate 1597, §18.4.3).

18.5.2 Strangers and the parish

Each Christian was to receive the Supper from his own pastor, who knew him and could judge his fitness. A stranger was not refused outright. He was first examined, and the orders require a reason.

Not without cause. The Albertine visitors' report of 1540 gives the rule in its shortest form: the pastors shall give the sacrament "to no stranger's parishioner without cause, so that each pastor may watch over his own sheep" (Sehling 1, p. 286). The visitors' order for Meissen of the same year repeats it (Sehling 2, p. 52). Henneberg's order of 1582 adds the reason. **Henneberg, *Kirchen-Ordnung* of Georg Ernst, 1582** (Sehling 2, p. 309):

And for this very reason no pastor shall give the Lord's Supper to a stranger's parishioner, except in need; since he cannot know his circumstances, and all manner of disorder may otherwise come of it.

Heard on their faith. Hesse's agenda of 1574 provides for foreigners who settle in a place. They are heard on their faith before the elders and admitted if they are found sound. If they are not, they are taught. **Hesse, *Agende*, 1574** (Philippist; Sehling 8, p. 435):

But since it also often happeneth that foreign, strange and unknown people betake themselves to a place to have their dwelling or abode there, and think to use the holy sacraments beside other known believing Christians: the ministers of the church shall first, before they be admitted to the use of the holy sacraments, hear and learn from such people, in the presence of the elders, what their faith and confession be; and, if they be found sound, take them to the communion with the others. But in case they be not yet sufficiently instructed in the doctrine, or be erring and wrong in any point, one shall instruct them in a Christian and brotherly way; and when they let themselves be taught and directed for the best, then, after examination first made and finding that their confession and faith is sufficient and sound, let them stand at baptism with other Christians and use the Lord's Supper.

The same paragraph stands in Nassau-Weilburg's order of 1576 (Sehling 10, p. 261) and in the order for the Corvey village of Bruchhausen of 1603 (Sehling 21, p. 262). The Nassau-Weilburg agenda of 1618 gave it the heading "How to proceed with strange, unknown persons, before they be admitted to the holy Supper". The Reformed synod of Wied (1564) has the same rule and gives its reason. **Wied, *Synodalbeschlüsse*, 1564** (Reformed; Sehling 19/1, p. 466):

11. Let no one be admitted to the Lord's Supper, especially strangers whose profession and life is not known to us and examined, unless they have first appeared before the pastor and given an account of their faith. Otherwise there will be no place for the anathema; nay, our churches will be the refuge of the wicked.

Not to escape one's own pastor. Leiningen's discipline order of 1566 forbade its subjects to receive the Supper anywhere else, even within the county, without their pastor's consent. Some had gone to "strange, even papist places" to spite a pastor with whom they were at odds. **Leiningen, *Kirchenzuchtordnung*, 1566** (Sehling 19/1, p. 228):

XIII. Of strange churches. We will also have this altogether observed by our subjects: that none receive the holy Supper at any other place in our county without his pastor's consent, nor have children baptized elsewhere. For certain of them, in contempt of

their pastor, where they bore him ill will, have run to strange, and even to papist, places before they were reconciled with their pastor, and have then received the most worthy Supper of our Lord Jesus Christ to their own judgment and damnation. On pain of twenty gulden, to be paid without remission.

Other orders asked about it at visitation or dealt with it in other ways:

- **Hohenlohe 1579** asks "whether anyone have his children baptized at other places, or go elsewhere to the Supper of our Lord Christ" (Sehling 15, p. 369).
- **Ulm 1586** admonishes "the foreign strangers from the peasantry", who come to the Supper in the city churches at the high feasts, to appear first for the examination (Sehling 17/2, p. 284).
- **Soest 1590** would not admit to the Supper without public penance those who had gone "to strange places" to be married without banns (Sehling 22, p. 480).

18.5.3 Communicants from Catholic and Reformed parishes

The rule of the own parish had one great exception. Where a person's own pastor was a papist who refused the Supper in both kinds, the Lutheran orders gave it to him. The Brandenburg-Nürnberg order of 1528 made this a rule. **Brandenburg-Nürnberg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1528** (Sehling 11, p. 138):

Of strangers' parishioners. To strangers' parishioners who are under pastors that refuse them the Christian sacraments, one shall minister, after good inquiry into their account and their faith, everything that is thus refused them at home against the word of God.

The printed order of 1533 kept the rule and fenced it. No pastor is to give the sacraments "lightly or without honest Christian cause" to those of other parishes, and he must first ask why they do not seek them at home. But if he knows the person, or the person "is under such a pastor, from whom he cannot obtain all Christian services", and a Christian mind is found in him, "nothing shall be refused him" (Sehling 11, pp. 198–199).

Forty years later Wolfstein repeated the rule and cited "our church order" for it. Sehling's editor identifies the passage as the Brandenburg-Nürnberg order of 1533. **Wolfstein, *Christliche Instructio* of Thomas Stieber, 1574** (Sehling 13, p. 572):

Tenthly, the pastors shall see to it that they do not lightly and without honest causes show the holy sacraments and other divine service to strangers' parishioners. But if known and Christian people come who cannot have the right use of the holy sacraments from their papist pastors, we shall in no wise refuse them such service, as is set down in our church order (page 171).

Prussia's order for the two bishops (1568) adds devout people "from the papacy", the sick and travellers. **Prussia, *Von Erwehlung der beiden bischoff*, 1568** (Sehling 4, p. 122):

that each pastor keep himself to the parish committed to him alone, and reach into no other's office without his knowledge and good will, nor let himself be persuaded thereto; and likewise receive no children of another's parish to confession or to the giving of holy baptism and the sacraments, but that each look to his own, as it is laid upon him to feed them with God's word. But if it should come to pass that good-hearted, godly people out of the papacy came to a pastor in our principality; or also one from a strange parish who fell sick in the place, or who was otherwise moved to Christian devotion in passing through, without contempt of his own pastor; and if he gave good account of his faith and condition, and for what cause he desired the sacrament in that place: the pastor shall refuse his service to none of these in his parish, but show himself willing with comfort and with the giving of the sacrament.

Pure sacraments. Schwäbisch Hall's order of 1615 turns the rule into a principle. The margin dates it to a decree of the chapter in 1564, repeated in 1570. A pastor gives the Supper to strangers whose own parishes "have not the holy sacraments pure and unalloyed". He sends back those whose parishes have them. The parishioner may do the same in reverse. **Schwäbisch Hall, *Kirchenordnung* 1543/1615** (Sehling 17/1, p. 141):

It is also asked here whether a pastor shall give the holy Supper to strangers' parishioners or not; and on the other hand, whether the parishioners may communicate with a strange pastor or not. Thereupon it is to be known that a pastor shall not refuse, but give, the holy Supper to strangers' parishioners who have not the holy sacraments pure and unalloyed in their parishes, when they come and desire it. But to those parishioners who have the holy sacraments pure and unalloyed in their parishes, a pastor shall not give the holy Supper, but refuse it, and send them to their pastor. […] So also the parishioners, when they have the holy sacraments pure and unalloyed at home in their parishes, shall seek the holy Supper there with their ordinary

pastor; but in the contrary case, seek the holy Supper at those places where it is found pure and unalloyed. This shall also be understood of the preaching of God's word.

The order cites Porta's *Pastorale Lutheri* (Luther's pastoral) and Felix Bidembach's *Consilia theologica* (Theological counsels) for the rule.

Sick Calvinists. Pfalz-Neuburg bordered on the Reformed Upper Palatinate. Its general articles of 1576 tolerate the papist ministers of foreign lordships while they give no offence. They let the pastor give the Supper to a sick Calvinist who has attended the evangelical sermons, "if the lordship can suffer it". **Pfalz-Neuburg, *Generalartikel*, 1576** (Sehling 13, p. 230):

In case also certain persons from Calvinist and other churches visit the evangelical churches and sermons in our principality, and one among them, being sick, should desire the evangelical pastor to give him the holy Supper: the pastor shall provide him with the holy sacrament, if the lordship can suffer it and it may be done without danger. But if it be dangerous, and against the will of the lordship or forbidden, he shall instruct such hearers with the ground of God's word and so strengthen them, that they may comfort themselves in case of bodily weakness befalling.

The next paragraph asks patience with those of the land who are "still contrary to the religion out of unequal understanding and simplicity". The pastors are to bear with them "as with the weak in faith, after the teaching of St Paul", and not set their conversion "for a certain, fixed time" (Sehling 13, p. 230).

Sehling's editor shows what this meant in practice. The Upper Palatinate forbade the going out, yet "the pastor of Lambrechtsneukirchen (near Burglengenfeld) in 1606 had among his 1,765 communicants, besides his 325 souls, 694 from the Upper Palatinate!" (Sehling 13, p. 230, editor's note).

18.5.4 Going out to another church (*Auslaufen*)

Wherever a territory bordered on another confession, its people went across the border to hear sermons and receive the sacraments. The orders call it *auslaufen*, "running out". Every confession forbade it, and every confession's people did it.

Lutheran and Upper German cities against the Mass. Strasbourg forbade its people to go out to the Mass two years after abolishing it. **Strasbourg, *Verbot, an anderen Orten die Messe zu hören*, 3 April 1531** (Moderate Reformed; Sehling 20/1, p. 224):

Our lords, master and council and the Twenty-one, command all and every burgher, resident and dependant, be it man or woman, young or old, of whatsoever dignity, estate or condition they be, none excepted, that none of them shall ride, drive or go out of this city of Strasbourg, neither to the Eich at Lingolsheim, nor to Wiwersheim, nor to such places, to other surrounding towns, market towns or villages, to hear Mass, on pain of five pounds of pennies, as often and as many times as it happeneth.

Frankfurt's council resolved the same in 1542. It also forbade the Catholic clergy of the city's three chapters to go out to the villages to preach and give the sacraments. **Frankfurt, *Resolution auf die Gravamina der Prediger*, 3 March 1542** (Sehling 9, p. 509):

That the burghers also, men and women, should be forbidden to run out to the villages to papist Masses and sermons, as hath been done hitherto; or, whoever would not refrain from it, that he should stay half a year out of Frankfurt.

Friedberg's council had forbidden the going out to the Masses at Rüsbach and Johannisberg in 1535, on pain of ten gulden (Sehling 9, p. 620, editor's note).

Strasbourg against the Reformed. By the end of the century Lutheran Strasbourg faced the other way. Its mandate of 1597 forbade going to "foreign lordships" for sermons and sacraments. Sehling's editor notes that the "contrary religion" meant chiefly the Reformed, who went to Bischweiler in Pfalz-Zweibrücken. **Strasbourg, *Verbot der Konventikel und des auswärtigen Gottesdienstbesuchs*, 10 December 1597** (Sehling 20/1, p. 535):

But contrary and against this it hath credibly come to us and been reported that certain of our burghers not only let themselves be misled and seduced by foreign preachers, who agree not with our confession and our church's profession, to a strange and contrary religion; but also lust to hold particular conventicles and assemblies in their houses, or, to the great offence of their neighbour, to drive out of the city on particular feast days into foreign lordships, to hear the sermons and use the sacraments.

The evangelicals of Catholic towns. Evangelicals living under a Catholic council or chapter went out to the evangelical villages round about:

- **Colmar.** The Catholic council tried in 1554 to stop its people going to the services in the neighbouring Württemberg lordship of Horburg, and renewed the mandate ten years later (Sehling 20/2, p. 475, editor). In 1560 the Horburg pastor wrote: *cives multi Colmarienses me adeunt* ("many citizens of Colmar come to me").
- **Hagenau.** The magistrates gave the going out as a reason for admitting evangelical worship in the city in 1565 (Sehling 20/2, p. 408, editor).
- **Wimpfen.** The burghers asked for the Supper in both kinds at home, so that they need not run "across the country to the villages or market towns of a foreign lordship" for it (Sehling 17/2, p. 513, editor).
- **Dinkelsbühl.** After 1559 more than a thousand people went out of the city each holy day (Sehling 12, p. 123, editor).
- **Dortmund.** The council freed the sacrament in both kinds in 1562, because many burghers had gone out "in great crowds to foreign places" to receive it.

Dortmund, *Mandat zur Freigabe des Abendmahls unter beiderlei Gestalt*, 1562 (Sehling 21, p. 216):

whereof many divisions have arisen among the common burghers; so also that certain persons, both men and women, have abstained altogether and entirely for many years from receiving the precious treasure of the holy sacrament, and certain have gone out in great crowds to foreign places, with their wives, children and servants, to receive the sacrament, as aforesaid.

In Reformed Bremen the Lutherans who had lost their last pastor in 1582 went out "to clergy outside the city and its territory, such as the pastor of Seehausen" (Sehling 7/2.2, p. 399, editor).

The Reformed territories against the Lutheran altars. The Reformed counties and the Reformed Palatinate forbade their people to go to Lutheran or Catholic neighbours. Nassau-Diez went furthest: a foreign pastor who gave the Supper in its villages was to be arrested. **Nassau-Diez, *Visitationspunkte*, 1585** (Reformed; Sehling 10, p. 178):

7. Whoever seeketh the Lord's Supper under a foreign lordship, or letteth his children be baptized in foreign churches, the same shall be put in the presentment roll, or, as the matter requireth, be reported to the authorities. But in case one or more should send for a strange, foreign pastor and receive the Supper from him, or would let their children be baptized by him, a general command shall go out from the high authority to each and every bailiff, that they take the same pastor, together with him who sent for him, prisoner forthwith, and deliver them into custody at Diez.

The Palatine church council complained in 1595 that "the running out of the hearers to foreign places for communion with the neighbouring Lutheran and Ubiquitist pastors" was becoming common. **Kurpfalz, *Mandat zur Institution und Polizeiordnung*, 16 August 1595** (Reformed; Sehling 19/2, p. 869):

Further, that the running out of the hearers to foreign places, to the communion with the neighbouring Lutheran and Ubiquitist pastors, is becoming too common and gaining the upper hand more and more, […] But upon the persons who run out to the foreign communion they shall keep diligent watch, and require a list of such persons from the ministers and elders of each place.

Other Reformed bans:

- **Hanau-Münzenberg.** A fine of three batzen for those "who run out into foreign lordships to the sermon or Supper" (*Kirchenzuchtordnung*, 1599/1602; Reformed; Sehling 10, p. 424). The visitors of 1599 asked "whether the people run elsewhere to the communion and have their children baptized elsewhere" (Sehling 10, p. 433).
- **Ysenburg.** The pastor is to announce each communion a week ahead, and to warn the people faithfully against "running out to foreign places under another lordship for baptism and the Supper" (*Kirchenordnung*, 1598; Reformed; Sehling 10, p. 646).
- **Sayn.** The elders were to report those "addicted to idolatry, who therefore run out elsewhere" (*Sendschöffenordnung*, 1606; Reformed; Sehling 19/1, p. 449). In 1619 the count forbade going to the "idolatrous, papal Mass" and pilgrimages at Marienstatt and elsewhere (Sehling 19/1, p. 454).
- **Homburg.** The people of Wiel were told in 1605 not to run to Marienhagen for the Supper, but to keep to their mother church (*Beschlüsse zu Homburger Kirchensachen*; Reformed; Sehling 22, p. 149).

A Calvinist in a Lutheran town. The Landau council's minutes of 1582 show the rule applied to one man. Dr Andreas Gottwald declared that he did not agree with "our churches" on the Supper. The pastor would not let Gottwald's wife lift a child from the

font. The council told Gottwald, if he would live in the town, to keep from disputing and from using the Supper under foreign lordships. **Landau, *Verhandlungen gegen Calvinisten*, 26 June 1582** (Sehling 19/1, p. 65):

namely, that he, Doctor Gottwald, if he would dwell here, should refrain not only from unnecessary disputation, but also from using the holy Supper under foreign lordships, outside the city; but if he would dwell here, that this should be done without offence to any man. […] Thereupon he declared that he would avoid all that which might be judged likely, on account of his person, to give offence to the common burghers, even in matters of faith. He would also attend the sermons here, so far as that could be done. But that he should receive the Supper here, that he knew not how to do.

The council answered that it "would prescribe him no measure in matters of religion", if only he gave no offence. In December the council ordered the preachers to examine the Calvinists, Schwenckfelders and Anabaptists, and resolved not to tolerate those who would not hear the sermons (Sehling 19/1, p. 65).

Reformed communicants at Lutheran altars. The Reformed theologians did not all forbid the Lutheran Supper. Sehling's editor reports their opinion from the Palatinate under the Lutheran Elector Ludwig VI. **Kurpfalz, Sehling's introduction** (Sehling 14, p. 67):

It is shown thereby that, despite the change of confession five years before, numerous Calvinists were still to be found in the land, although the running out to the Reformed Supper in the territory of Johann Casimir had been forbidden them in 1578. Thereupon Reformed theologians such as Beza and Ursinus had examined in opinions the participation of the Reformed-minded in Lutheran celebrations of the Supper, and approved it in principle.

The same account is repeated in the introduction to the supplement (Sehling 19/2, p. 684).

18.6 Confession and absolution

The question "who could absolve whom" has two sides in the orders. One is whose absolution counted. The other is from whom a Christian might seek it.

18.6.1 Not from monks and priests

The first evangelical orders took confession away from the monks. Bugenhagen's Hamburg order of 1529 gives it to those who preach. **Hamburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1529** (Sehling 5, p. 508):

Hearing confession and giving the sacrament. Those who openly set forth God's word to us shall also minister the sacraments and hear confession, especially in the last necessities. For of others, and especially of monks, we might have suspicion that they would not deal rightly with the people in the doctrine of the holy gospel, especially in secret confession and in the last necessities.

The Upper German catechisms are sharper. They deny that the papists' absolution has any force at all. **Strasbourg, Wolfgang Capito's *Kinder bericht*, 1527** (Moderate Reformed; Sehling 20/1, p. 193):

Question: What is the priests' forgiveness or absolution? Answer: A very evil deceit; for the papists, since they insist on their little human sins, have themselves no part in the kingdom of God. How then might they open it to other people?

Konrad Sam's catechism for Ulm says the same, and draws the practical consequence. **Ulm, Konrad Sam's catechism, 1528/1536** (Moderate Reformed; Sehling 17/2, p. 108):

The monks' or priests' absolution or forgiveness is a deceit. They are not Christians, for they insist not on the words of Christ but on their little human sins. Therefore go far from them, as from the worst enemies of God.

18.6.2 Not to the defenders of error

The orders also refuse their own absolution to those who defend another confession's errors:

- **Prussia 1568.** The order keeps confession so that the preacher may refuse absolution and the sacrament to "the papists, Sacramentarian fanatics, Anabaptists and other sects like them" who defend their errors (§18.5.1).

- **Lippe 1571.** The minister is to see that "proven, convicted heretics and persecutors or falsifiers of the truth" are not absolved (Sehling 21, p. 380).
- **Posen 1570.** On the Polish side, those excommunicated in one congregation are not admitted to the Supper in the other until they are reconciled with the church they offended (art. XV, §18.11.3).

18.6.3 One's own confessor

One's own pastor. Most orders tie confession to the parish, so that discipline may hold. The Prussian order for the bishops (1568) forbids a pastor to receive another parish's people to confession (§18.5.3). Soest's preachers agreed on the same in 1590. **Soest, *Artikel der Prediger*, 1 September 1590** (Sehling 22, p. 480):

5. Since a pastor knoweth his sheep and their circumstances best, and also that church discipline may be maintained, no one shall accept another's penitents without the foreknowledge and will of their pastor.

Absolution stolen elsewhere. Lippe's order of 1571 describes what the rule prevented. **Lippe, *Kirchenordnung*, 1571** (Sehling 21, p. 380):

Since it also often happeneth that certain excommunicated people, or people turned away from the communion, run out of their parish into another congregation, and there steal the absolution from the pastor and receive the sacrament of the altar with other God-fearing Christians (that they may be held godly and holy by the people), because it is refused and denied them in their own parish, together with other rights of the church, on account of their godless life and impenitence: this shall be prudently prevented and forborne by the preachers, as faithful watchmen of souls, so that no one break into another pastor's office.

Any minister of the city. Regensburg had one evangelical ministry in several churches. Its order of 1572 took for granted that people chose their confessor from the whole ministry, "since they all have one office and equal power". It asked only that they confess where they meant to commune, so that the number of communicants in each church might be known. **Regensburg, *Kirchenregimentsordnung*, 1572/1588** (Sehling 13, p. 509):

moreover, many gather to one minister of the church while meantime the other sitteth idle, since commonly each chooseth for himself a particular father confessor, though they all have one office and equal power: therefore the reverend ministers, when they are in doubt whether a person will communicate in the church in which he confesseth, shall ask and admonish him on that account, henceforth to make his confession at the place where he is always wont to communicate.

The pastor's own confessor. Henneberg's order of 1582 asks the country pastors, who had no second minister beside them, to seek absolution "once or several times a year" from their neighbouring pastors (Sehling 2, p. 307).

18.7 Ordination

The evangelical ordination, and why it was begun, are treated in §13.10. This section takes up the fellowship side: whose orders the evangelical churches accepted, and whose they did not.

18.7.1 Orders received from the bishops

The evangelical preachers were ordained in the old church. The first generation of preachers had been ordained priests by the bishops. The Hannover order of 1536 makes this a point of its defence: it was the papists who cast out men they had themselves ordained. **Hannover, *Kirchenordnung*, 1536** (Sehling 6/2, p. 997):

When our Christian preachers attacked and rebuked the papist ways, they were banned by the papists, and so thrust out by the ban from the papists' church, in which they had yet been ordained and called to the office of preaching, which they might not forsake with a good conscience.

Ordination for those not yet ordained. When the evangelical churches began to ordain, they ordained only those who had no orders. Sehling's editor reports the Electoral Saxon decree of 12 May 1535. The superintendents were to send candidates "so far as they had not yet received episcopal consecration" to Wittenberg to be ordained. "This ordination was conceived as a parallel to, or a substitute for, episcopal ordination to the priesthood" (Sehling 7/1, p. 728, editor). The Hoya order of 1581 still speaks of ordaining "the persons who are not ordained" (Sehling 6/2, p. 1132).

The later orders did not ordain again one already ordained:

- **Brunswick 1571.** The city's order of calling, signed by Chemnitz, says that if the person called "was ordained before elsewhere", he needs "no further ordination", only a public presentation to the congregation (Sehling 6/1, p. 458).
- **Strasbourg 1598.** A pastor who had been examined and ordained before in the Strasbourg ministry was not ordained again. Only one new to the ministry was examined and ordained (Sehling 20/1, pp. 661–662).

The bishop of Breslau. In Silesia the line between the old ordination and the new was drawn late. **Silesia, Sehling's introduction** (Sehling 3, p. 391):

For a long time the Liegnitz superintendents Heinrich Dietrich and Georg Seiler recognised the bishop's jurisdiction and did not dispute his right of ordination. In Pless the bishop's jurisdiction was recognised for decisions in the second instance even as late as 1592.

The bishops' consecration refused. In the north the evangelical churches gave up waiting for the bishops. The Hamburg order of 1556 gives the reason: the bishops ordained only for the Mass. The text follows Buxtehude's order of 1552 (Sehling 7/1, p. 84). **Hamburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1556** (Sehling 5, p. 549):

Forasmuch as the bishops' consecration is at this time given only for the idolatrous papist abuses and only for the godless service, and yet an honourable and godly ordination and institution is needful, the institution may not unfittingly be done as the holy apostles gave it, and as hath been customary in our church until now, namely with prayer and the laying on of hands.

Einbeck's chapter order of 1543 makes the same point about benefices: the duke's presentees were to be admitted to their prebends "though they be not smeared with oil and chrism after the papist manner, nor consecrated, or otherwise have a defect of birth" (*Stiftsordnung* of Duke Philip I; Sehling 6/2, p. 1117).

18.7.2 Re-ordination, and orders taken from the papists

The orders accepted Roman orders. They did not re-ordain a priest who came over to them. The corpus has one exception. **Pfalz-Neuburg, *Generalartikel*, 1576** (Sehling 13, p. 198):

that priests come out of the papacy, confess our true Christian religion and desire a ministry of the church, and since it may yet come to pass in time to come that such persons apply for service: the same, notwithstanding that he received his ordination and *formata* (letters of orders) in the papacy, shall be ordained again at the church committed to him, in the stead of a recantation, and a certificate thereof given him.

The order does not call the Roman orders void. The new ordination stands "in the stead of a recantation": the priest renounced the papacy by being ordained again before his new congregation.

Taking orders from the papists. Magdeburg's pastors in 1554 went the other way: they would not hold for Christians those who took orders or prebends from the papists. **Magdeburg, *Etliche artikel zu notwendiger kirchenordnung*, 1554, fifth article** (Sehling 2, p. 452):

The fifth article. Of those who receive orders or consecration or prebends from the papists, for themselves, their children or their kin. […] Therefore those who accept orders, consecration, prebends or benefices from the Antichrist, or from those who are still wholly unconverted papists, for themselves, their children or friends, we cannot hold for Christians; since they take wages from the Antichrist, and bind themselves to him and his members.

The Catholic side. The Roman side, in turn, did not accept Wittenberg orders. In 1539, on the complaint of Amberg's Catholic town pastor, the Count Palatine demanded the removal of all clergy "who were married or not ordained in the Roman way". The city "had at last to let Hügel go, because he was ordained by Luther and not by a bishop" (Sehling 13, p. 258, editor).

18.7.3 Proof of orders

Because orders were accepted across territories, they had to be proved. Most orders gave the new minister a certificate. Lauenburg's says why. **Lauenburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1585** (Sehling 5, p. 408):

After the communion the one ordained shall forthwith be given his trustworthy certificate of ordination, sealed by the superintendent and signed beside him by the other pastors present, for a witness of his orderly calling, and that he hath been

admitted to the holy office of preaching, and is no false preacher.

A certificate could also state the confession of the man ordained. Pfalz-Zweibrücken's of 1567 names the errors he renounced, and puts Calvin's doctrine of the Supper first. **Pfalz-Zweibrücken, *Ordinationszeugnis*, 7 September 1567** (Sehling 18, p. 343):

he hath testified that he is a stranger to all fanatical opinions that fight against the word of God (such as is Calvin's error concerning the Lord's Supper, Schwenckfeld's blasphemy against the ministry of the word, the madness of the Anabaptists who assail the baptism of infants and the civil magistrate, the fiction of Origen and others concerning free will, and like corruptions).

Other orders show how far the certificates travelled:

- **Visitation questions.** The visitors asked by whom and where each minister was ordained. The Sponheim articles of 1608 require each minister to report to the chancery "where, when and by whom he was ordained" (Sehling 18, p. 672).
- **Brunswick's ministry.** Under Mörlin and Chemnitz it was often asked by other territories for a *testimonium ordinationis* (certificate of ordination) for their preachers. Certificates survive from 1558 to 1568 for men called to Tating in Holstein, to Hannover and elsewhere (Sehling 6/1, p. 343, editor).
- **Danzig.** In 1586 the council took the right of ordination from the city's quarrelling clergy, and had the necessary ordinations done by the consistory at Stolp in Pomerania (Sehling 4, pp. 172–173, editor).

Poland: a minister of either confession. The Polish union let a congregation call a minister ordained in the other confession. **Synod of Petrikau, 1–3 June 1578** (Sandomierz consensus; Sehling 4, p. 263):

VI. It is decreed that no patron shall receive any minister, or suffer him to teach in the church, unless he have been lawfully ordained and sent by the superintendents and seniors of our churches, and have a good and sure testimony from them. VII. Since a union hath been made among us who are devoted to the Helvetic, Augsburg and Bohemian confessions, it shall be free for the church or patron of a congregation of one confession, for just causes and in good order, to ask a minister from the superintendents of the other confession and to call him.

The synod of Thorn in 1595 added that no minister was to be received "unless he be rightly ordained, have a sure testimony, and subscribe the Consensus and conduct himself according to it" (art. IV; Sehling 4, p. 265).

18.8 Preaching

18.8.1 No preaching without a call

Every order requires a call for the pulpit:

- **Brandenburg-Ansbach 1536.** The visitors were to tell the ministers to let no one "who is not called and examined" preach or give the sacraments (Sehling 11, p. 323).
- **Pfalz-Zweibrücken 1567.** The certificate of ordination sets against the called minister those who "without awaiting a lawful calling, by private choice invade the public office of teaching in the church", with Jeremiah 23:21: "they ran, and I sent them not" (Sehling 18, p. 343).

The rule was not only evangelical. The Roman Catholic humanist order of Jülich-Cleves-Berg used it against the evangelical preachers. **Jülich-Cleves-Berg, *Deklaration zur Kirchenordnung*, 8 April 1533** (Roman Catholic humanist; Sehling 21, p. 61):

that in our principalities, lands and territories the aforesaid strange and hedge preachers be in no wise tolerated or maintained any longer; and that no other preachers be accepted in any other manner than the rightful pastors and their vicars, admitted by our appointed councillors; and that none shall send for, fetch, hear, house, lodge or maintain the strangers or those not admitted.

18.8.2 Strangers in the pulpit

No pastor might let a strange preacher into his pulpit without leave. Reuss gives the rule its shortest form. **Reuss, *Kirchen-Ordnung* of Heinrich IV, 1552** (Sehling 2, p. 157):

No pastor shall let any strange, unknown preacher into the pulpit without the foreknowledge of the superattendent, for great mischief hath often arisen thereof.

The leave came from different bodies in different places:

- **The superintendent and the lord.** Nassau-Dillenburg 1550: no "young or strange predicant" without the lord and the superintendent (Sehling 10, p. 91).
- **The whole ministry.** Wismar's settlement of 1572: no unknown preacher "without the knowledge and consent of the whole ministry". The superintendent might preach in the other parish churches except on the highest feasts, after warning the local pastor (Sehling 5, p. 313).
- **The council.** Aschersleben 1575: "no strange person into the pulpit" without the council's consent (Sehling 2, p. 477).
- **The chancery or the inspectors.** Sponheim 1608, under the heading "No stranger shall preach": no minister may let "another and strange theologian" preach in his church or its filials without the chancery or the inspectors knowing (Sehling 18, p. 672).
- **Certificates.** Wittgenstein's order of 1555 admits a foreign preacher to a vacant parish only with certificates "both of his honourable and chaste life and of the soundness of his doctrine" from the places where he served before (Sehling 22, p. 83).

By the end of the century the rule served the confession. The Soest preachers would let no one into the pulpit until they knew "to which body of doctrine each one confesseth". **Soest, *Artikel der Prediger*, 1 September 1590** (Sehling 22, p. 480):

2. Since great mischief may also arise from letting young and also unknown people come into the pulpit, without knowing to which body of doctrine each one confesseth: none among us shall henceforth let anyone come into the pulpit to preach, unless he have been set before the whole ministry and spoken with as need requireth.

Only the Polish union opened the pulpit to the other confession. Its ministers preached in each other's churches (§18.11.3). In mixed Wimpfen the hearers of each religion might go to the other's sermon (§18.9.2).

18.8.3 The other confession's ministers, and the pulpit

No fellowship, no disputes. Wolfstein's instruction of 1574 lays two rules on its pastors. They are to have no fellowship with the papist priests, citing 1 Timothy 6 and 2 John 10–11. And they are not to dispute with foreign pastors, Calvinist or papist. **Wolfstein, *Christliche Instructio* of Thomas Stieber, 1574** (Sehling 13, pp. 590–591):

Twelfthly, all pastors under our gracious lord shall abstain and keep themselves from all papist priests, and have no fellowship with them; that our hearers may see and know in deed that our preaching against the idolatrous papacy floweth from an upright heart and a fervent zeal for pure doctrine […] It is very unseemly and offensive that we should have much fellowship with those whom in our sermons we proclaim enemies of our Lord Christ and condemn as idolaters. […] *If there come any unto you, and bring not this doctrine, receive him not into your house, neither bid him God speed: for he that biddeth him God speed is partaker of his evil deeds* [2 John 10–11]. Thirteenthly, all pastors and ministers of the church dwelling in our gracious lord's land and lordship shall refrain from engaging in disputations and offensive quarrels with foreign pastors, be they Calvinist or papist; from which little good followeth, and such adversaries of ours will hardly let themselves be taught, and thereby worldly lordships are also often set against one another and moved and provoked to unpeaceable ill will.

Sehling's editor glosses the Calvinist pastors as those "for instance in Electoral Palatine Amberg". If a Wolfstein pastor was asked for an account of his faith, he was to give it briefly "in all fear of God" (1 Peter 3:15).

Naming without reviling. Where the lord was of another religion, or the town held two, the pulpit was bridled:

- **Sponheim 1599.** The pastor of Kastellaun, where the margravine resided, asked whether he might name "the papists and the ass, the pope". He was told he might expound the orthodox doctrine "in thesis and antithesis" and name the other party. But he was to keep from odious epithets and preach "to edify and not to destroy". All pastors were to name the adversaries in the disputed articles, "so that the hearers know of which party one speaketh": papists, Anabaptists, Schwenckfelders, Calvinists. But they were to do it without epithets joined "with injury and contumely" (Sehling 18, p. 663).
- **Colmar.** The magistrate summoned the deacon Johann Georg Magnus over an Ascension sermon against the Zwinglians. He was told to leave such "subtleties" off the pulpit and not to use the names "Zwinglians" and "Calvinists" (Sehling 20/2, p. 485, editor).
- **Augsburg 1591.** The preacher's oath in the biconfessional city (§18.9.3).
- **Wimpfen 1568.** Both pastors were to keep from "reviling, scolding and slandering" (§18.9.3).

The Reformed side: no condemnations. The Reformed governments made the same rule in their own interest. In the Upper Palatinate no one was admitted to a church or school office "unless he vow upon the *mandatum de non calumniando*". **Upper Palatinate, *Generalanweisung*, 20 March 1598** (Reformed; Sehling 13, p. 348):

13. Likewise no one shall be admitted to any church or school office unless he vow upon the *mandate against calumny*; over which mandate the church councillors shall be bound to hold stiffly and fast among those related to both religions, and in this case to wink no more at the orthodox than at the others.

The Reformed recess for Lutheran Amberg (1593) admitted Jacob Schopper as city preacher on the same condition. He was to refrain "from all reviling and bitter calumny and condemnation (*salva tamen thesi et antithesi*)" (Sehling 13, p. 336). In Hessian Katzenelnbogen in 1600 the ministers were told to leave off "the calumnies, insults and condemnations" in the points still disputed "between the evangelical churches", on both sides. They were not to bring onto the pulpit new phrases of the omnipresence of Christ's flesh, or of its "corporal and real in-existence in or under the bread and wine" (Reformed; Sehling 9, p. 60).

The Reformed Kurpfalz grounded its mandate against condemnations of 1584 on the Lutheran fathers themselves (§18.11.1).

18.9 Prayer and worship side by side

18.9.1 Prayer for, and against, the other confessions

No order outside Poland provides for common worship with another confession. But the orders pray about the others in the general prayer and the litany, both for them and against them.

For the heretics. The early Upper German and Franconian orders pray for their conversion. Heilbronn's order of 1530 has the preacher pray in the general prayer "for heretics and the obstinate, always a special prayer for each". **Heilbronn, *Confessio Heilbronnensis* and *Kirchenordnung*, 1530** (Sehling 17/1, p. 286):

After the same the preacher holdeth the common prayer, praying diligently for the Christian shepherds, for the temporal magistrates, emperor, king, princes etc., for the sick and weak, for the common peace, for the enemies of Christian blood, for the fruit of the earth, for heretics and the obstinate: always a special prayer for each.

Ulm's handbook of 1531 bids prayer for heretics and apostates beside the Jews and heathen. **Ulm, *Handbüchlein*, 1531** (Moderate Reformed; Sehling 17/2, p. 176):

To pray for all unbelieving Jews, heathen, heretics and apostates from the church of Christ: that God the Lord would root out all false, erring unbelief, and daily increase and enlarge his kingdom; that Christ our Lord would call and bring hither, through his gracious, mighty word, all whom the Father hath given him, that we may all be one sheepfold, and he, our only shepherd and saviour, be made known also to the heathen and to all men.

The Brandenburg-Ansbach *Auctuarium* of the Interim (1548) puts prayers "for unbelievers, sects and factions" in the place of the minor and major canon (Interim order; Sehling 11, p. 327).

Against them. The later Lutheran orders pray against the other confessions as enemies of the word:

- **Regensburg 1567.** The general prayer asks that God's word may remain pure "against all the tyranny and falsification of the Turk, the pope, the heretics, tyrants and false brethren" (Sehling 13, p. 479).
- **Pfalz-Zweibrücken 1565.** The duke sent the parishes a prayer "against the Turk and the sectaries", that is, "the heretics, sectaries and fanatics" (Sehling 18, p. 311).
- **Kurland 1570.** The general instruction drops the Ave Maria. It has the litany sung on Sundays "very vehemently against the pope, the Turk", the devil and all his members.

Kurland, *Instructio generalis*, 1570 (Sehling 5, p. 80):

The Ave Maria, used out of papist custom, shall be done away in time; and commonly on Sunday the litany shall be sung, and prayer made very vehemently against the pope, the Turk, Gog and Magog, Meshech and the tents of Kedar, the devil himself and all his members, tyrants and heretics.

The same instruction has the prayer bell rung three times a day, with prayer "against the devil and his members, tyrants and heretics, pope, Turks and their consorts" (Sehling 5, p. 92).

Could the others pray? The godparent rules turned on this question (§18.4.3). For the Bremen preachers a papist's prayer was "nothing but mere sin and curse", since it was without faith in Christ. For the Hessian visitors of 1556 the papists "confess one faith with us". Regensburg asked of the godparent that he be one "who can and shall pray to God with" the church.

18.9.2 At the other confession's worship

The orders say little about a Christian present at the worship of another confession on a single occasion. Two texts give opposite answers.

To the church door. Pfalz-Neuburg's general articles of 1576 deal with subjects invited to a wedding in a Catholic territory. They may attend the wedding but not the Mass. **Pfalz-Neuburg, *Generalartikel*, 1576, art. LXIV.3** (Sehling 13, p. 231):

3. If it should then come to pass that anyone from this principality be invited to weddings in the papacy, and might, with others, be present at the papist Mass out of want of understanding, the pastors shall summon such persons also and deal with them discreetly, and give them sufficient instruction, on the good ground of holy Scripture, of what an idolatry and abomination before God the Mass is, and dissuade them from it. But in case such a person would gladly be at the wedding, they shall direct him to go no further than the church door; or, if he come into the church with the others, to turn back at once and go out, and in no wise to stay at the idolatry, to the wounding of his conscience and the offence of other people, nor confirm it by his presence.

The same article deals with children placed in service in the papacy. The pastor is to warn such a child to keep to what it has learned, to stay clear of idolatry, and to come to him when it wishes to communicate (Sehling 13, p. 231).

Into the other's sermon. At Wimpfen, where the Catholics and the Augsburg Confession shared one parish church, the council's agreement of 1568 let each side hear the other. **Wimpfen, *Regelung der Predigtzeiten und Festtage beider Konfessionen*, 23 July 1568** (Sehling 17/2, p. 520):

Likewise also both parish vicars shall be diligent in modesty in their sermons, and moderate and refrain from reviling, scolding and slandering; but each of them shall so set forth the necessary things of his doctrine, that the other and his parishioners be not touched with reviling nor put to shame thereby. The parish vicars themselves and their hearers may also go unhindered into the other's sermons; yet, as is fitting, keep silence, not interrupt the preacher, nor act against him in any way with gestures, and otherwise leave his parishioners unmolested in word and deed.

18.9.3 Two religions in one town

The Peace of Augsburg (1555) left the imperial cities where both religions were then practised to keep both. A number of the orders are the settlements by which councils, chapters and lords divided the churches, the hours and the pulpits.

Wimpfen. The 1568 agreement divides the Sunday morning between the two parish vicars. The Catholic preacher and ceremonies are to end by eight, or at the latest half past eight, in summer, and by half past eight or nine in winter. Then the Augsburg Confession has the church. After the midday meal the evangelical catechism is held at one, and the Catholic vespers after it. The agreement also lists the feasts both sides keep (Sehling 17/2, pp. 519–521).

Augsburg. The city held "both the old religion and the Augsburg Confession". Its preachers swore to keep the peace between them. **Augsburg, *Einzelbestimmungen zu den Berufungsverhandlungen*, 1591** (Sehling 12, p. 115):

and, since in the city of Augsburg both the old religion and the Augsburg Confession are kept, I will wholly refrain from blaspheming, disgracing and reviling persons, and from all that may serve to the unrest, ill will and embitterment of the common man; and will abide, in expounding and declaring the holy gospel, by the sense of the Augsburg Confession.

Amberg. The Reformed Elector's recess of 1593 for Lutheran Amberg left every inhabitant free to choose between the two churches. **Upper Palatinate, *Amberger Rezeß*, 8 June 1593** (Reformed; Sehling 13, p. 337):

And it shall now be free and open to all burghers, inhabitants and strangers, without any reviling, reproach, upbraiding or penalty, to confess themselves to the one church or the other, its sermons and sacraments, and to visit and use them; and no

less shall each of them, of whatever religion he be, show and conduct himself toward the other peaceably, quietly and kindly, as burghers and inhabitants of one city; and protection and defence shall be held for the one as for the other.

Hagenau. The council of 1614 separated the two religions "in churches and also in schools", and gave each its own buildings. **Hagenau, *Fundationsbrief*, 3 June 1614** (Sehling 20/2, p. 463):

for since we have in this our city the two religions admitted in the Holy Roman Empire, as they are named, the old or Catholic and the Augsburg Confession, side by side, and have declared ourselves to maintain them without any compulsion or oppression of conscience, and to admit, protect and uphold each man in the one or the other to which his conscience driveth him: [we resolved] that we would separate the two sides or parties from one another, in churches as also in schools

Other settlements:

- **Wetzlar.** The town and the chapter shared the collegiate church after an agreement of 1561 (Sehling 9, p. 674). In 1586 the council received some sixty families of the Walloon Reformed refugee congregation from Wesel. Sehling's editor adds that they used the choir of the former Franciscan church and the Lutherans its nave. This made a second shared church, "of the Lutherans and Reformed" (Sehling 9, p. 670, editor).
- **Leutkirch.** In the calendar dispute of 1603 the council held all burghers "of the Catholic Roman or of the Augsburg Confession religion" in equal protection. It declared the calendar "for no religious but a political matter" (Sehling 17/2, p. 546).
- **The Wild- and Rhinegraviate.** The Wild- and Rhinegraves shared the lordship of Vinstingen with Catholic co-lords. Their treaty of 13 January 1584 let the co-lords' subjects in the villages have Catholic worship, with churches and priests at the co-lords' cost. The Rhinegraves promised to protect the Catholic pastors, priests, schoolmasters and subjects "in their church usages, ceremonies and exercise of their religion" (Sehling 19/2, p. 551).
- **Samter.** In Greater Poland the two lords of Samter agreed in 1575 on the common use of the parish church for Catholic and Protestant worship (Sehling 4, p. 255, editor).

Schools. The Transylvanian synod of Mediasch (1578) recalled the Saxon scholars "from the schools of Klausenburg", which Sehling's editor calls "dominated by another confession". The obstinate were to have no office in the Saxon schools or churches (art. XVIII; Sehling 24, p. 427). The Kraków synod of 1573 held it "wrong" for evangelical parents to send their children "to the schools of blasphemers and idolaters" (Sehling 4, p. 261).

18.10 Burial and marriage

18.10.1 Burial

The churchyard closed to obstinate papists. Christian burial was refused to those who died outside the church. Magdeburg's pastors in 1554 gave the Catholic practice as their warrant. **Magdeburg, *Etliche artikel zu notwendiger kirchenordnung*, 1554, fourth article** (Sehling 2, p. 451):

The fourth article. Of those who are mere papists and remain so to their end. Those who die as pure, hardened papists and enemies of the gospel of Christ, of the right use of the sacraments and of the right church, ought rightly to be wholly refused our churchyard, where the Christians lie and sleep; lest a mingling be made between the bones of the Christians and of the open, declared and final enemies of Christ. […] Moreover the papists use such earnestness against us evangelicals that they will not let us be buried in their supposed consecrated churchyards, so that, as they pretend, their holy places might not be defiled with our bodies. How much more shall we Christians show a Christian zeal in this point.

The Hoya order of 1581 sends to "the common field" the impenitent despisers of the word, the heretics, and "hardened papist people, if they die without repentance". **Hoya, *Kirchenordnung*, 1581** (Sehling 6/2, p. 1172):

further, heretics, blasphemers and persecutors of the truth who remain in their godless ways; and lastly, hardened papist people, if they should die and depart without repentance: they shall be set apart from the burial of the Christians, and buried in the common field; for they are not worthy to rest in the common God's acres, where other godly Christians have their little sleeping chambers and rest in Christ.

Other orders on burial:

- **Mansfeld 1580.** The agenda refuses Christian burial, with bells and singing, to those held fast in "false, heretical and condemned doctrine", who avoid the church and the sacraments and revile pure doctrine, if they die unrepentant. The grounds are 2 John and Titus 3 (§18.3; Sehling 2, pp. 246–247).
- **Regensburg 1567.** The church order makes separate provision for "those who are not of our doctrine and confession", and for those who "desire to be buried among the papists" (Sehling 13, p. 483).
- **Wied 1564 (Reformed).** Whoever dies in obstinate contempt of God and his gospel is to be "deprived of the common burial of the faithful" (Sehling 19/1, p. 466).

18.10.2 Marriage between spouses of unequal religion

The orders did not dissolve a marriage for difference of religion. Lauenburg's order of 1585 applies 1 Corinthians 7, and makes the one exception that Paul makes. **Lauenburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1585** (Sehling 5, p. 441):

But if, without the knowledge of the other party, the one had been of an unsound religion from the beginning, or had afterwards become of a false, unchristian religion while the marriage stood, it is clear that those who would tear apart and separate the marriage between such spouses on account of unequal religion and faith act openly against Paul, and also against many examples and histories; unless the one party should therefore maliciously forsake and run from the other, as often happeneth among the Anabaptists. For in such a case help must be given to the innocent party, according to the doctrine of the apostle Paul.

The Anabaptist side is stated in Pfalz-Zweibrücken's order of 1557, among the Anabaptist errors: "if an Anabaptist is in marriage, and the other person will not hold to the Anabaptists' error, he may leave her and take another" (Sehling 18, p. 147).

Marriages into the other confession were discouraged, not forbidden. Pfalz-Neuburg's articles of 1576 tell the pastors to preach "with all discretion" against parents who "marry their children into the papacy". Such parents are to be summoned and warned of the danger. If the children are "defiled with idolatry", the superintendent is to admonish the parents to help them out of the papacy again (art. LXIV.1; Sehling 13, pp. 230–231).

18.11 Agreements between the traditions

18.11.1 The Wittenberg Concord and its memory

Strasbourg's account. The Strasbourg church order of 1598 tells the history of its own fellowship with Saxony. It begins with the Elector at Augsburg in 1530, who "had no fellowship with those commonly held to be Zwinglian, nor afterwards, until they declared their mind" (Sehling 20/1, p. 557). Then it comes to the Concord. **Strasbourg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1598** (Sehling 20/1, p. 558):

Hereupon at last, in the year 1536, the agreement between the Saxon and the Upper German churches followed. In it they not only agreed with one another on the article of the holy Supper, infant baptism and private absolution, but also on both sides declared themselves roundly for the Augsburg Confession and Apology of the electors and princes, which were at that time still unaltered.

The Concord was taken into the orders of the Upper German cities. Ulm's visitation articles of 1537 bind the preachers to teach of the sacrament "according to the council's order and also its declaration on the Wittenberg Concord" (Moderate Reformed; Sehling 17/2, p. 198). In 1564 Pfalz-Neuburg and Pfalz-Zweibrücken prescribed the Concord's phrases for preaching on the Supper against the Calvinists (§17.12.3; Sehling 13, p. 148; 18, p. 317).

The Reformed reading. The Reformed Palatinate read the same history the other way. Its mandate of 1584 against condemnations argued that the makers of the concords had acknowledged one another as brothers. **Kurpfalz, *Mandat gegen Kondemnationen*, 1584** (Reformed; Sehling 14, p. 512):

since it is certain and sure that such learned men and ministers of the church, according to the concords and brotherly agreement made with one another not only in the year [15]29 at Marburg, but much more in the year [15]36 at Wittenberg, were one in the foundation in all the chief points of our Christian faith, also in the matter of holy baptism and of the holy Supper, and acknowledged one another as brothers

18.11.2 Prussia and the Bohemian Brethren, 1549

Duke Albrecht received the Bohemian Brethren who fled to Prussia in 1549, after examining their confession. Sehling's editor summarises the archival record. **Prussia, Sehling's introduction** (Sehling 4, p. 22):

We learn from this act that the Bohemians, who are also called Picards and Waldensians, had come to Prussia; that their preachers had been summoned to Königsberg and examined for the testing of their faith; that they had handed over their confession of faith, printed at Wittenberg by Georg Rau in 1538, and their doctrine had been found blameless; that they did not, it is true, agree with Prussia in the ceremonies, but these were things indifferent, and they would keep in future to the order of the land. They were therefore received, and twenty-one articles were prescribed to them, whose author was Staphylus.

The visitation of Soldau in 1578 shows the later aim: that the Bohemians should be absorbed into the native church (Sehling 4, p. 22, editor).

18.11.3 Poland: the Consensus of Sandomierz and its synods

In Poland the Lutherans, the Reformed and the Bohemian Brethren made a union in 1570. It is the only text in the corpus in which churches of different confessions grant one another fellowship in word and sacrament. Each side recognised the other's doctrine of the chief articles as orthodox. **Synod of Sandomierz, 14 April 1570** (Sandomierz consensus; Sehling 4, p. 257):

First, as we who have published our confession in the present synod, and the Brethren, have never believed that those who embrace the Augsburg Confession think otherwise than piously and orthodoxly of God and the holy Trinity, and of the incarnation of the Son of God, and of our justification, and of the other chief heads of our faith: so also those who follow the Augsburg Confession have professed candidly and sincerely that they in turn acknowledge nothing in the confession, both of our churches and of the Bohemian Brethren (whom certain men ignorant of the facts call Waldensians), concerning God and the holy Triad, the incarnation of the Son of God, justification, and the other primary heads of the Christian faith, that is discordant with the orthodox truth and the pure word of God.

The Consensus binds the churches to maintain the union by hearing the word and using the sacraments in each other's congregations. **Synod of Sandomierz, 14 April 1570** (Sandomierz consensus; Sehling 4, p. 258):

Moreover we undertake by mutual consent that we will persuade all our brethren with all zeal, and invite them, to embrace, cherish and preserve this Christian and unanimous consensus, and to nourish and seal it, chiefly by the hearing of the word (frequenting the assemblies both of this and of each other confession) and by the use of the sacraments; yet keeping the right order and degree both of the discipline and of the custom of each church.

The Posen articles. The synod of Posen in May 1570 turned the Consensus into rules. They answer most of this chapter's questions for Poland. **Synod of Posen, *Consignatio*, 20 May 1570** (Sandomierz consensus; Sehling 4, p. 259):

II. Let the ministers of both parts both preach sermons in the churches and administer and dispense the sacraments, in the same form and rite as is customary with them, and that without any suspicion of offence. III. If in any place there be two ministers, one of each congregation, or if by any chance the one meet the other or be called, they ought without any suspicion of offence to administer both sermons and sacraments, promoting the glory of God with the same, and that a pure and candid, mind. IV. Wherever there is a pastor of the one congregation, the patron of that place ought not to call and receive a pastor of the other congregation to preach sermons and administer the sacraments without the consent of his own minister […] VI. Let neither part by any means or occasion draw away the ministers and hearers of the other part, but confirm and further them in the fellowship of the same congregation. VII. Let the ministers of both parts teach and admonish their hearers, and enjoin them by their pastoral authority, that they dare not condemn the churches of the other confession in all points of doctrine and rites, nor touch them with any words or writings, but think and speak well of them. […] XIV. Let the ministers of neither part admit to the use of the sacraments hearers coming from the other part, without the testimony of the pastor under whose own care they lie; except at diets, at a general synod, or perhaps on some journey. XV. Let those excommunicated by one congregation by the authority of Christ's keys not be admitted to the holy Supper in the other congregation, unless they have first been reconciled with the church which they offended.

Article XVIII of the same articles lists exorcism first among the "papistical ceremonies and rites" to be done away by degrees. Then follow images, relics, the superstitious use of candles, the consecration of herbs, banners, and gold and silver crosses (Sehling 4, p. 259).

The later synods renewed the union and adjusted it:

- **Kraków 1573.** The synod renewed the Consensus and the Posen articles. It left the Brethren and the Augsburg churches free to keep "their own rites and customs", especially concerning the superintendent, the seniors and synods (Sehling 4, p. 260). It broke off all dealings with the Arian Anabaptists (§18.3).
- **Petrikau 1578.** A congregation might call a minister from the superintendents of the other confession (§18.7.3). Standing or kneeling at the Supper was left free, and sitting rejected (§2.15.3).
- **Włocławek 1583.** The synod judged it "superfluous" to subscribe the new Harmony of confessions published in Switzerland, since Poland had its own "sure norm and bond" of concord.

Synod of Włocławek (Wladislaw), 20 June 1583 (Sandomierz consensus; Sehling 4, pp. 263–264):

IV. Concerning the Harmony of the evangelical confessions (lately published among the Swiss with godly zeal and skilful labour), the decision went to this opinion: since we in Poland and Lithuania etc. have by divine favour a sure norm and bond of our concord, the Consensus of Sandomierz etc., which we happily use as a banner of peace, joined in one army of the Lord, we judge it superfluous to subscribe that Harmony or other formulas of concord, and to bring them into our churches.

Thorn 1595. The last synod of the union in the corpus explained article XIII of the Posen articles. A Christian is not so bound to his own minister that he may never use the other's, for instance when the other's church is nearer. But no minister may receive those who leave their own pastor to escape his discipline. **Synod of Thorn, 1595** (Sandomierz consensus; Sehling 4, p. 266):

Declaring the thirteenth article of the *Consignatio*, we judge thus: that the little sheep of Christ ought not to be so subjected to the dominion and yoke of any minister that it be not lawful for them, when just causes and circumstances intervene, to use the services of the ministers of the other congregation and order; for example, having regard to the circumstance of the place and the nearness of the church, and on like occasions, and for fair reasons and causes. But if any hearers who stir up offences and live impiously, offended at the discipline and rebuke of their own pastor, would depart from him and commit themselves to the care of another pastor for the sake of greater licence and impunity in sinning, the minister of the other congregation ought by no means to receive such.

The same synod set common days of public prayer and fasting for "all our evangelical churches", on the four Ember days of the year (art. XV; Sehling 4, p. 267).

Before the union. Five years before Sandomierz the Lutheran synod of Gostyń had bound its ministers to the Augsburg Confession. **Synod of Gostyń, 1565** (Sehling 4, p. 268):

Art. 1. We all profess with one spirit the purity of the evangelical doctrine and also of the administration of the sacraments; and we abhor and condemn those who think and teach otherwise.

18.11.4 Two congregations under one lord

Rappoltstein, 1561. In the Leber valley under the lords of Rappoltstein there were two congregations: a Lutheran German one and a Reformed French one. In May 1561 their lord had them meet to see whether they could agree in confession and ceremonies. The French pastor, Arnaud Banc, offered to sign the Augsburg Confession if articles 10 and 11 were rightly interpreted. The German side then put four demands. **Rappoltstein, *Vergleich zwischen der deutschen und der französischen Gemeinde*, 28 May 1561** (Reformed; Sehling 20/2, p. 133):

When thereupon the judge had asked the assessors, he declared to the pastor that it was the Germans' mind that he should put these four articles to his congregation: 1. Whether the same would accept and subscribe the Augsburg Confession; 2. Whether they would keep like ceremonies with the Germans; 3. If anything were to be changed, that the same should not happen without the consent of the German church; 4. Whether the French church would acknowledge the German as the head.

The French congregation accepted the Augsburg Confession, with articles 10 and 11 "godly and rightly interpreted". It kept its freedom in ceremonies and refused to be subordinate. On 8 June 1561 the lord, Egenolph IV, decided that both churches might keep their own ceremonies and usages. The Germans had the Mattenkirche near Markirch, the French the church at Eckerich (Sehling 20/2, pp. 102–103, editor). The editor adds that the Strasbourg ministry's president, Marbach, had found "a Genevan phrase" in the French confession. He objected to its articles on predestination, its rejection of emergency baptism and its exclusion of unbelievers from the Supper (Sehling 20/2, p. 100, editor).

The strangers' church at Frankfurt, 1554. The Walloon refugees whom Valérand Poullain brought to Frankfurt in 1554 had the council's leave to use the church of the Weißfrauen convent (Sehling 9, p. 489, editor). Their *Liturgia sacra* (Sacred Liturgy;

Reformed) requires every member to subscribe the congregation's confession first. The confession's title says it must be approved and subscribed "before they are either reckoned to the church or communicate in any part of the sacraments in the church of strangers at Frankfurt". The English exiles signed it "in the name of their whole church" (Sehling 9, p. 586). The council had let the English share the Weißfrauen church only on condition that they "joined the ceremonies of the Walloons and formed no separatist congregation" (Sehling 9, p. 490, editor).

18.12 How the rules changed

The rules moved with the confessional map. In the first decades the other church was Rome. From the 1560s the Lutheran orders turned against the "Sacramentarians". From the 1580s the Reformed territories turned the same rules against the Lutherans.

1520s and 1530s: separation from Rome.

- **Absolution.** The first orders took confession from the monks (Hamburg 1529) and called the priests' absolution a deceit (Capito 1527, Sam 1528) (§18.6.1).
- **The Supper.** It was closed to papists and to those who denied the presence (Reutlingen c. 1531). It was opened to the evangelical-minded parishioners of papist pastors (Brandenburg-Nürnberg 1528, 1533) (§18.5).
- **Going out.** The cities forbade their people to go out to the Mass (Strasbourg 1531; Friedberg 1535; Frankfurt 1542) (§18.5.4).
- **Prayer.** The orders prayed for heretics and the obstinate (Heilbronn 1530, Ulm 1531) (§18.9.1).
- **Ordination.** The preachers still held Roman orders, and their churches defended them (Hannover 1536). From 1535 Wittenberg ordained only those who lacked episcopal orders (§18.7.1).
- **Agreements.** The Wittenberg Concord of 1536 joined the Saxon and the Upper German churches (Ulm 1537) (§18.11.1).
- **The Catholic side.** Jülich-Cleves-Berg (1533) shut out the strange preachers, and the Count Palatine's government at Amberg (1539) would not have a minister ordained by Luther.

1540s and 1550s: the evangelical churches order their own.

- **The parish.** The Albertine visitors (1540) bound the Supper to the parish.
- **Ordination.** The *Wittenberg Reformation* (1545) would still have taken ordination from bishops who accepted the gospel (§13.10.1). Buxtehude (1552) and Hamburg (1556) gave up the bishops' consecration as given "only for the godless service" (§18.7.1).
- **The Interim.** Brandenburg-Ansbach's *Auctuarium* (1548) prayed for unbelievers and sects in place of the canon.
- **The Brethren.** Prussia received the Bohemian Brethren (1549) after examining their confession (§18.11.2).
- **Hard and soft lines.** Magdeburg (1554) closed sacrament, font and churchyard to obstinate papists, and would not hold for Christians those who took papist orders. Hesse (1556; Moderate Reformed) admitted papists as godparents. Waldeck (1556) and Rostock (1557) shut the papists, Anabaptists and Sacramentarians out of the Supper (§18.5.1).
- **The Peace of Augsburg (1555).** It is the frame for the later settlements in towns of two religions (§18.9.3).

1560s and 1570s: against the Sacramentarians.

- **Fellowship.** The Sacramentarians became the chief "other" of the Lutheran orders. Bremen (1561) would have no Sacramentarian godparents. Pfalz-Zweibrücken (1564) forbade fellowship with them, and its ordinands renounced "Calvin's error" (1567). Kurland (1570) and Hohenlohe (1579) listed every sect with which a Christian might have no fellowship (§18.3).
- **Baptism.** Lay baptism and exorcism became marks of confession (Wolfstein 1574; later Henneberg 1582, Soest 1609) (§18.4.1).
- **Ministers.** Wolfstein (1574) forbade disputes with Calvinist and papist pastors alike (§18.8.3).
- **Mixed towns.** Settlements were made at Wetzlar (1561), Rappoltstein (1561), Hagenau (1565) and Wimpfen (1568) (§18.9.3, §18.11.4).
- **Poland.** The Lutheran synod of Gostyń (1565) still condemned those who thought otherwise. Five years later the Consensus of Sandomierz (1570) and the Posen articles opened pulpit and altar between Lutherans, Reformed and Brethren. Kraków (1573) and Petrikau (1578) renewed them (§18.11.3).
- **Patience.** Pfalz-Neuburg (1576) and Electoral Saxony (1580) admitted papists and erring Sacramentarians as godparents, and Pfalz-Neuburg gave the Supper to sick Calvinists. The same Pfalz-Neuburg re-ordained priests from the papacy "in the stead of a recantation" (§18.7.2).

1580s to the 1610s: the Reformed territories and the Lutheran answer.

- **Reformed rules.** The counties of the Wetterau and the Rhine and the Palatinate turned Reformed, and made their own fellowship rules. Nassau-Dillenburg (1582) admitted to the Supper only those who confessed "the Reformed doctrine". Nassau-Diez (1585) had foreign pastors arrested. Kurpfalz (1595), Hanau (1599/1602), Ysenburg (1598), Sayn (1606, 1619) and Homburg (1605) forbade going out to Lutheran or Catholic neighbours (§18.5.4).
- **Reformed pulpits.** Kurpfalz (1584), the Upper Palatinate (1598) and Katzenelnbogen (1600) forbade condemnations of the other evangelicals (§18.8.3).
- **Lutheran rules.** The Lutheran orders answered:
  - Landau (1582) refused a Calvinist godmother and kept a Calvinist doctor from the Supper abroad.
  - Soest (1590) asked for the "body of doctrine" before admitting a preacher to the pulpit.
  - The Wild- and Rhinegraviate (1597) held that to commune with a church is to belong to it.
  - Strasbourg (1597) forbade its burghers to go to the Reformed at Bischweiler.
  - Schwäbisch Hall (1615, after decrees of 1564 and 1570) let the people seek "pure" sacraments where they were to be found.
- **Exceptions.** Strasbourg's magistrate (1601) would not bar Calvinist godparents. Beza and Ursinus approved Reformed communion at Lutheran altars. Lambrechtsneukirchen gave the Supper to 694 people from the Reformed Upper Palatinate in 1606.
- **Cities of two religions.** Augsburg (1591), Amberg (1593), Leutkirch (1603) and Hagenau (1614) bound their preachers to keep the peace (§18.9.3).
- **Poland.** Włocławek (1583) and Thorn (1595) renewed the union. Thorn let Christians use the other confession's minister for just cause, and set common days of prayer and fasting for all the united churches (§18.11.3).

What did not change was the baptism. No order in the corpus repeats a baptism given in the name of the Trinity, whether by a priest, a midwife or a heretic (§18.4.1).

18.13 Table by order

The table lists every order quoted or cited above, grouped by region and in date order within each region. **Rule** gives the order's rule on fellowship in a few words. Orders that are not Lutheran are labelled, and the editors' accounts are marked as Sehling's introduction or note.

Saxony, Thuringia and central Germany

Order	Date	Rule	§
Electoral Saxony, decree of Elector Johann Friedrich (Sehling's editor)	1535	Candidates without episcopal orders to be ordained at Wittenberg	18.7.1
Albertine Saxony, *Gemeiner bericht der visitatorn*	1540	No stranger's parishioner at the Supper "without cause"	18.5.2
Meissen, *Ordnung der Visitatoren für die Stadt Meissen*	1540	The same rule	18.5.2
Ernestine Saxony, *Constitution … consistorii zu Wittemberg*	1542	Only godparents "of our true and Christian religion"	18.4.3
Reuss, *Kirchen-Ordnung* of Heinrich IV	1552	No strange preacher in the pulpit without the superintendent	18.8.2
Magdeburg, *Etliche artikel zu notwendiger kirchenordnung*	1554	Obstinate papists refused the sacrament, the font and the churchyard; those who take papist orders not held Christians	18.4.3, 18.5.1, 18.7.2, 18.10.1
Aschersleben, *Kirchen-Agenda*	1575	No strange person in the pulpit without the council	18.8.2

Order	Date	Rule	§
Electoral Saxony, *Kirchenordnung* of Elector August	1580	Papists and erring Sacramentarians admitted as godparents; no Lutheran at a papist baptism	18.4.3
Mansfeld, *Kirchen-agenda*	1580	Heretics to be avoided (2 John, Titus 3) and refused Christian burial	18.3, 18.10.1
Henneberg, *Kirchen-Ordnung* of Georg Ernst	1582	Exorcism kept against the Zwinglians; no stranger at the Supper except in need; pastors absolved by their neighbours	18.4.1, 18.5.2, 18.6.3

Silesia, Prussia, the Polish cities and Pomerania

Order	Date	Rule	§
Silesia, Sehling's introduction	—	The Liegnitz superintendents left the bishop of Breslau his right to ordain	18.7.1
Prussia, Sehling's introduction	1549	The Bohemian Brethren received after examination; ceremonies indifferent	18.11.2
Prussia, *Kirchenordnung und ceremonien*	1568	No absolution or sacrament for those who defend papist, Sacramentarian or Anabaptist errors	18.5.1, 18.6.2
Prussia, *Von Erwehlung der beiden bischoff*	1568	Each pastor to his own parish; the godly from the papacy, the sick and travellers served	18.5.3, 18.6.3
Thorn, *Kirchenordnung*	after 1560	Baptism refused to papists who sought it only for rich godparents	18.4.2
Danzig, Sehling's introduction	1586	Ordinations done by the consistory of Stolp	18.7.3

Poland: the Sandomierz consensus

Order	Date	Rule	§
Synod of Gostyń	1565	Those who teach otherwise condemned	18.11.3
Synod of Sandomierz (Sandomierz consensus)	14 April 1570	Each side's doctrine owned as orthodox; hearing and sacraments in each other's congregations	18.11.3
Synod of Posen, *Consignatio* (Sandomierz consensus)	20 May 1570	Ministers of both sides preach and give the sacraments in each other's churches; testimony for communicants; excommunicates; exorcism to go	18.4.1, 18.6.2, 18.11.3
Synod of Kraków (Sandomierz consensus)	1573	No dealings with the Arian Anabaptists; rites left free; no schools of blasphemers	18.3, 18.9.3, 18.11.3
Synod of Petrikau (Sandomierz consensus)	1–3 June 1578	A minister may be called from the other confession's superintendents	18.7.3, 18.11.3
Synod of Włocławek (Wladislaw) (Sandomierz consensus)	20 June 1583	The Swiss Harmony of confessions superfluous	18.11.3
Synod of Thorn (Sandomierz consensus)	1595	The other side's minister for just cause; no minister without a certificate; common days of prayer and fasting	18.7.3, 18.11.3
Samter, agreement of the two lords (Sehling's introduction)	1575	One parish church for Catholic and Protestant worship	18.9.3

Mecklenburg, Kurland, Lauenburg and Hamburg

Order	Date	Rule	§
Hamburg, *Kirchenordnung*	1529	Confession heard only by those who preach	18.6.1
Buxtehude, *Kirchenordnung*	1552	The bishops' consecration given only for the Mass	18.7.1
Hamburg, *Kirchenordnung*	1556	The same; ordination with prayer and the laying on of hands	18.7.1
Rostock, *Visitations-Instruktion*	1557	Blasphemers who hold to the papist idolatry turned away from Supper and font	18.5.1
Kurland, *Kurländische Kirchenreformation*	1570	No fellowship with any sect; none of them invited as godparents	18.3
Kurland, *Instructio generalis*	1570	The litany sung against the pope, the Turk and the heretics	18.9.1
Wismar, *Abschied*	1572	No unknown preacher without the whole ministry	18.8.2
Lauenburg, *Kirchenordnung*	1585	Certificate of ordination; no divorce for unequal religion	18.7.3, 18.10.2

Lower Saxony

Order	Date	Rule	§
Hannover, *Kirchenordnung*	1536	Parted from Rome over doctrine; preachers ordained in the church that banned them	18.3, 18.7.1
Einbeck, *Stiftsordnung* of Duke Philip I	1543	Presentees admitted without papist anointing	18.7.1
Wolfenbüttel, *Kirchenordnung*	1569	Baptism in the papacy "right and complete"	18.4.1
Brunswick, *Vokationsordnung für die Prediger*	1571	No second ordination for one ordained elsewhere	18.7.1
Brunswick, Sehling's introduction	1558–1568	Certificates of ordination for preachers called elsewhere	18.7.3
Oldenburg, *Kirchenordnung*	1573	Baptism in the papacy valid (after Wolfenbüttel)	18.4.1
Hoya, *Kirchenordnung*	1581	Those not ordained to be ordained; hardened papists buried in the field	18.7.1, 18.10.1

The north-west

Order	Date	Rule	§
Jülich-Cleves-Berg, *Deklaration zur Kirchenordnung* (Roman Catholic humanist)	8 April 1533	Strange and hedge preachers not tolerated	18.8.1
Wittgenstein, *Kirchenordnung*	1555	A foreign preacher admitted only with certificates	18.8.2
Bremen, *Stellungnahme der Prediger zu den Anfragen der Wittheit*	1561	No papist or Sacramentarian godparents; papists cannot pray	18.4.2, 18.4.3, 18.9.1
Dortmund, *Mandat zur Freigabe des Abendmahls unter beiderlei Gestalt*	1562	Both kinds freed, since burghers went out for them	18.5.4

Order	Date	Rule	§
Lippe, *Kirchenordnung*	1571	Excommunicates not to steal absolution elsewhere; heretics not absolved	18.6.2, 18.6.3
Moers, *Kirchenordnung* (Reformed)	1581	Emergency baptism by laymen rejected (editor's note)	18.4.1
Bremen, Sehling's introduction	after 1582	The Lutherans of Reformed Bremen go out to the pastor of Seehausen	18.5.4
Soest, *Artikel der Prediger*	1 September 1590	No papist or Calvinist godparents; own confessor; no preacher before the ministry	18.4.3, 18.5.2, 18.6.3, 18.8.2
Corvey, *Kirchenordnung für Bruchhausen*	1603	Strangers heard on their faith (after Hesse)	18.5.2
Homburg, *Beschlüsse zu Homburger Kirchensachen* (Reformed)	1605	No running to Marienhagen for the Supper	18.5.4
Soest, *Kirchenordnung*	1609	Exorcism free, but defended against the Sacramentarians	18.4.1

Hesse and its neighbours

Order	Date	Rule	§
Hesse, *Kasseler Kirchenordnung* (Moderate Reformed)	1539	Emergency baptism by laymen rejected (editor's note)	18.4.1
Frankfurt, *Resolution auf die Gravamina der Prediger*	3 March 1542	No running to the papist Masses in the villages	18.5.4
Nassau-Dillenburg, *Visitationsordnung*	1550	No strange preacher without the lord and the superintendent	18.8.2
Frankfurt, *Liturgia sacra* (Sacred Liturgy) of the French congregation (Reformed)	1554	The confession subscribed before communion	18.11.4
Hesse, visitation article of 1556, in the editor's note to the *Abschied der ersten Generalsynode*, 1568 (Moderate Reformed)	1556	Papists admitted as godparents	18.4.3
Waldeck, *Kirchenordnung*	1556	No papist, Anabaptist or Sacramentarian at the Lord's table until he revoke	18.5.1
Wetzlar, *Vergleich zwischen Stift und Stadt*; the Walloon refugees (Sehling's introduction)	1561, 1586	Churches shared with the Catholics, and with the Reformed	18.9.3
Hesse, *Agende* (Philippist)	1574	Strangers heard on their faith before the elders	18.5.2
Nassau-Weilburg, *Kirchenordnung* (and *Agende*, 1618)	1576	The same rule, after Hesse	18.5.2
Nassau-Diez, *Visitationspunkte* (Reformed)	1585	A foreign pastor who gives the Supper to be arrested	18.5.4
Ysenburg, *Kirchenordnung* (Reformed)	1598	The people warned against going out for baptism and the Supper	18.5.4
Hanau-Münzenberg, *Kirchenzuchtordnung* and visitation questions (Reformed)	1599/1602	Fines for going out to foreign lordships	18.5.4

Order	Date	Rule	§
Katzenelnbogen, points for the ministers (Reformed)	1600	No condemnations of the other evangelicals; no ubiquitist phrases	18.8.3
Friedberg, council's ban (editor's note)	1535	No going out to the Mass at Rüsbach and Johannisberg	18.5.4

The Palatinates and the Rhine

Order	Date	Rule	§
Pfalz-Zweibrücken, *Kirchenordnung*	1557	The Anabaptist error that a spouse may leave an unbeliever	18.10.2
Kurpfalz, *Kirchenordnung* (Reformed)	1563	Baptism by the minister alone (editor's note)	18.4.1
Pfalz-Neuburg, *Mandat gegen die Kalvinisten*	1564	The Wittenberg Concord's phrases for preaching on the Supper	18.11.1
Pfalz-Zweibrücken, *Mandat gegen die Calvinisten*	1564	No fellowship or letters with Sacramentarian fanatics	18.3, 18.11.1
Wied, *Synodalbeschlüsse* (Reformed)	5 June 1564	Strangers to give account of their faith; the contumacious denied burial	18.5.2, 18.10.1
Pfalz-Zweibrücken, *Fürbittenmandate*	1565	Prayer against the Turk and the sectaries	18.9.1
Leiningen, *Kirchenzuchtordnung*	1566	No Supper or baptism elsewhere without one's pastor	18.5.2
Pfalz-Zweibrücken, *Ordinationszeugnis*	7 September 1567	The ordinand renounces "Calvin's error"; no office without a call	18.7.3, 18.8.1
Pfalz-Neuburg, *Generalartikel*	1576	Papist godparents with discretion; sick Calvinists given the Supper; priests re-ordained; a Catholic wedding only to the church door	18.4.3, 18.5.3, 18.7.2, 18.9.2, 18.10.2
Kurpfalz, Sehling's introduction	1578	Beza and Ursinus approve Reformed communion at Lutheran altars	18.5.4
Landau, *Verhandlungen gegen Calvinisten*	26 June 1582	A Calvinist godmother refused; a Calvinist doctor kept from the Supper abroad	18.5.4
Kurpfalz, *Mandat gegen Kondemnationen* (Reformed)	1584	The makers of the concords "acknowledged one another as brothers"	18.8.3, 18.11.1
Vinstingen, *Erster Vertrag über die Konfession der Herrschaft*	13 January 1584	Catholic worship protected under Lutheran co-lords	18.9.3
Upper Palatinate, *Amberger Rezeß* (Reformed)	8 June 1593	Free choice between the churches; Schopper's promise not to condemn	18.8.3, 18.9.3
Kurpfalz, *Mandat zur Institution und Polizeiordnung* (Reformed)	16 August 1595	Against going out to the Lutheran and Ubiquitist pastors	18.5.4
Wild- and Rhinegraviate, *Patenordnung*	1597	To commune with a church is to belong to it	18.4.3, 18.5.1
Upper Palatinate, *Generalanweisung* (Reformed)	20 March 1598	No office without a vow on the *mandatum de non calumniando* (mandate against calumny)	18.8.3
Sponheim, *Generalartikel*	1599	The adversaries to be named without odious epithets	18.8.3

Order	Date	Rule	§
Wild- and Rhinegraviate, *Kirchenordnung*	after 1603	No erring godparents	18.4.3
Sayn, *Sendschöffenordnung* (and *Kirchenordnungsmandat*, 1619) (Reformed)	1606	Against going out to the Mass and pilgrimages	18.5.4
Sponheim, *Generalartikel*	1608	No stranger in the pulpit; each minister to report by whom he was ordained	18.7.3, 18.8.2

Franconia, Regensburg and Bavaria

Order	Date	Rule	§
Brandenburg-Nürnberg, *Kirchenordnung*	1528	The sacraments ministered to the parishioners of pastors who refuse them	18.5.3
Brandenburg-Nürnberg, *Kirchenordnung*	1533	The same, after inquiry	18.5.3
Brandenburg-Ansbach, *Kirchenvisitation*	1536	No one to preach who is not called and examined	18.8.1
Amberg, Sehling's introduction	1539	Hügel dismissed, as ordained by Luther and not by a bishop	18.7.2
Brandenburg-Ansbach, *Auctuarium* (Interim order)	1548	Prayer for unbelievers and sects in place of the canon	18.9.1
Regensburg, *Kirchenordnung*	1567(?)	No papist godparents; prayer against pope and heretics; separate burial	18.4.3, 18.9.1, 18.10.1
Regensburg, *Kirchenregimentsordnung*	1572/1588	A confessor chosen from the whole ministry	18.6.3
Wolfstein, *Christliche Instructio* of Thomas Stieber	1574	Emergency baptism kept against the Calvinists; papists' parishioners served; no fellowship with papist priests; no disputes	18.4.1, 18.5.3, 18.8.3

Württemberg, Hohenlohe and Swabia

Order	Date	Rule	§
Ulm, Konrad Sam's catechism (Moderate Reformed)	1528/1536	The priests' absolution a deceit	18.6.1
Heilbronn, *Confessio Heilbronnensis* and *Kirchenordnung*	1530	Prayer for heretics and the obstinate	18.9.1
Reutlingen, *Kirchenordnung*	c. 1531	No papists, strangers or deniers of the presence at the Supper	18.5.1
Ulm, *Handbüchlein* (Moderate Reformed)	1531	Prayer for heretics and apostates	18.9.1
Ulm, *Visitationsartikel* (Moderate Reformed)	1537	Preaching by the Wittenberg Concord	18.11.1
Württemberg, *Visitationsordnung*	1557	Sectaries visited privately; returning Anabaptists' children baptized	18.4.2, 18.5.1

Order	Date	Rule	§
Württemberg, *Visitationsordnung für die Superintendenten*	1559	Visitation question on fellowship with sectaries	18.3
Wimpfen, Sehling's introduction	—	Burghers go out to foreign villages for both kinds	18.5.4
Wimpfen, *Regelung der Predigtzeiten und Festtage beider Konfessionen*	23 July 1568	One church, divided hours; each may hear the other's sermon; no reviling	18.8.3, 18.9.2, 18.9.3
Hohenlohe, *Visitation*	1571	Visitation question on fellowship with sectaries	18.3
Hohenlohe, *Kapitels- und Visitationsordnung*	1579	No fellowship with Jews or papist priests; question on communing elsewhere	18.3, 18.5.2
Hohenlohe, *Kirchen- und Schulordnungen*, consistory order	1582	The Electoral Saxon rule on godparents, on Andreae's advice	18.4.3
Ulm, *Berichte und Ratsentscheide zur Einzelbeichte*	1586	Foreign peasants at the Supper to be examined	18.5.2
Augsburg, *Einzelbestimmungen zu den Berufungsverhandlungen*	1591	No reviling in a city of two religions	18.8.3, 18.9.3
Dinkelsbühl, Sehling's introduction	after 1559	Over a thousand go out of the city each holy day	18.5.4
Leutkirch, *Dekret für die Bürgerschaft zum Kalenderstreit*	1603	Both religions equally protected	18.9.3
Limpurg, *Visitationsordnung*	1611	Visitation question on fellowship with sectaries	18.3
Schwäbisch Hall, *Kirchenordnung* 1543/1615	1614/1615	Well-disposed papists as godparents (draft); pure sacraments sought where they are found	18.4.3, 18.5.3

Strasbourg, Alsace and Transylvania

Order	Date	Rule	§
Strasbourg, Wolfgang Capito's *Kinder bericht* (Moderate Reformed)	1527	The priests' absolution a deceit	18.6.1
Strasbourg, *Verbot, an anderen Orten die Messe zu hören* (Moderate Reformed)	3 April 1531	No going out to hear Mass	18.5.4
Colmar, Sehling's introduction	1554, 1564	The Catholic council against going to Horburg; a preacher told not to name the Zwinglians	18.5.4, 18.8.3
Rappoltstein, *Vergleich zwischen der deutschen und der französischen Gemeinde* (Reformed)	28 May 1561	Each church keeps its own ceremonies	18.11.4
Hagenau, Sehling's introduction	1565	Going out given as a reason to admit evangelical worship	18.5.4
Strasbourg, *Verbot der Konventikel und des auswärtigen Gottesdienstbesuchs*	10 December 1597	No going to the Reformed in foreign lordships	18.5.4

Order	Date	Rule	§
Strasbourg, *Kirchenordnung*	9 April 1598	The history of the Concord; no second ordination	18.7.1, 18.11.1
Strasbourg, *Stellungnahme des Magistrats … wegen der reformierten Taufpaten*	28 March 1601	Calvinist godparents not barred	18.4.3
Hagenau, *Fundationsbrief*	3 June 1614	The two religions separated in churches and schools	18.9.3
Transylvanian Saxons, Honterus, *Reformationsbüchlein*, German version	1543	Baptism by laymen, heathen and heretics not repeated	18.4.1
Transylvanian Saxons, articles and common order	1577, 1578	No fellowship with the open enemies of God	18.3
Mediasch synod	1578	Children of Gypsies and Romanians sent to their own congregations; scholars recalled from Klausenburg	18.4.1, 18.4.2, 18.9.3

18.14 Concordance of the orders quoted

Every order quoted in this chapter is listed below by region, in the order of the table above. The table gives:

- **Sehling**: the volume and pages in Sehling's edition.
- **Doc**: the `eko.db` document that holds the text, for full-text lookup. A single database record may hold several orders.
- **§**: the sections where the order is quoted.

Saxony, Thuringia and central Germany

Order	Sehling	Doc	§
Reuss, *Kirchen-Ordnung* of Heinrich IV, 1552	2, p. 157	1234	18.8.2
Magdeburg, *Etliche artikel zu notwendiger kirchenordnung*, 1554	2, pp. 451–452	1257	18.4.3, 18.5.1, 18.7.2, 18.10.1
Electoral Saxony, *Kirchenordnung* of Elector August, 1580	1, pp. 432–433	44	18.4.3
Mansfeld, *Kirchen-agenda*, 1580	2, pp. 246–247	1241	18.3, 18.10.1
Henneberg, *Kirchen-Ordnung* of Georg Ernst, 1582	2, pp. 305, 307, 309	1247	18.4.1, 18.5.2, 18.6.3

Silesia, Prussia, the Polish cities and Pomerania

Order	Sehling	Doc	§
Silesia, Sehling's introduction	3, p. 391	1803	18.7.1
Prussia, Sehling's introduction, 1549	4, p. 22	1830	18.11.2
Prussia, *Kirchenordnung und ceremonien*, 1568	4, pp. 76–77	1833	18.5.1, 18.6.2
Prussia, *Von Erwehlung der beiden bischoff*, 1568	4, p. 122	1833	18.5.3, 18.6.3
Thorn, *Kirchenordnung*, after 1560	4, p. 230	1844	18.4.2

Poland: the Sandomierz consensus

Order	Sehling	Doc	§
Synod of Gostyń, 1565	4, p. 268	1846	18.11.3
Synod of Sandomierz, 14 April 1570 (Sandomierz consensus)	4, pp. 257–258	1846	18.11.3
Synod of Posen, *Consignatio*, 20 May 1570 (Sandomierz consensus)	4, p. 259	1846	18.4.1, 18.6.2, 18.11.3
Synod of Kraków, 1573 (Sandomierz consensus)	4, pp. 260–262	1846	18.3, 18.9.3, 18.11.3
Synod of Petrikau, 1–3 June 1578 (Sandomierz consensus)	4, p. 263	1846	18.7.3, 18.11.3
Synod of Włocławek (Wladislaw), 20 June 1583 (Sandomierz consensus)	4, pp. 263–264	1846	18.11.3
Synod of Thorn, 1595 (Sandomierz consensus)	4, pp. 265–267	1846	18.7.3, 18.11.3

Mecklenburg, Kurland, Lauenburg and Hamburg

Order	Sehling	Doc	§
Hamburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1529	5, p. 508	1959	18.6.1
Hamburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1556	5, p. 549	1963	18.7.1
Kurland, *Kurländische Kirchenreformation*, 1570	5, p. 64	1906	18.3
Kurland, *Instructio generalis*, 1570	5, pp. 80, 92	1907	18.9.1
Lauenburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1585	5, pp. 408, 441	1953	18.7.3, 18.10.2

Lower Saxony

Order	Sehling	Doc	§
Hannover, *Kirchenordnung*, 1536	6/2, pp. 997, 999	2051	18.3, 18.7.1
Wolfenbüttel, *Kirchenordnung*, 1569	6/1, p. 124	1974	18.4.1
Hoya, *Kirchenordnung*, 1581	6/2, pp. 1132, 1172	2065	18.7.1, 18.10.1

The north-west

Order	Sehling	Doc	§
Jülich-Cleves-Berg, *Deklaration zur Kirchenordnung*, 8 April 1533 (Roman Catholic humanist)	21, p. 61	1421	18.8.1
Bremen, *Stellungnahme der Prediger zu den Anfragen der Wittheit*, 1561	7/2.2, pp. 526–527	2221	18.4.2, 18.4.3, 18.9.1
Dortmund, *Mandat zur Freigabe des Abendmahls unter beiderlei Gestalt*, 1562	21, p. 216	1447	18.5.4
Lippe, *Kirchenordnung*, 1571	21, p. 380	1462	18.6.2, 18.6.3
Soest, *Artikel der Prediger*, 1 September 1590	22, p. 480	1536	18.4.3, 18.5.2, 18.6.3, 18.8.2

Hesse and its neighbours

Order	Sehling	Doc	§
Frankfurt, *Resolution auf die Gravamina der Prediger*, 3 March 1542	9, p. 509	2332	18.5.4

Order	Sehling	Doc	§
Hesse, visitation article of 1556, in the editor's note to the *Abschied der ersten Generalsynode*, 1568 (Moderate Reformed)	8, pp. 349–350	2263	18.4.3
Waldeck, *Kirchenordnung*, 1556	9, p. 250	2300	18.5.1
Hesse, *Agende*, 1574 (Philippist)	8, p. 435	2272	18.5.2
Nassau-Diez, *Visitationspunkte*, 1585 (Reformed)	10, p. 178	189	18.5.4

The Palatinates and the Rhine

Order	Sehling	Doc	§
Pfalz-Zweibrücken, *Mandat gegen die Calvinisten*, 1564	18, pp. 316–317	981	18.3, 18.11.1
Wied, *Synodalbeschlüsse*, 5 June 1564 (Reformed)	19/1, p. 466	1094	18.5.2, 18.10.1
Leiningen, *Kirchenzuchtordnung*, 1566	19/1, p. 228	1073	18.5.2
Pfalz-Zweibrücken, *Ordinationszeugnis*, 7 September 1567	18, p. 343	987	18.7.3, 18.8.1
Pfalz-Neuburg, *Generalartikel*, 1576	13, pp. 188, 198, 230–231	404	18.4.3, 18.5.3, 18.7.2, 18.9.2, 18.10.2
Kurpfalz, Sehling's introduction, 1578	14, p. 67	468	18.5.4
Landau, *Verhandlungen gegen Calvinisten*, 26 June 1582	19/1, p. 65	1046	18.5.4
Kurpfalz, *Mandat gegen Kondemnationen*, 1584 (Reformed)	14, p. 512	507	18.8.3, 18.11.1
Upper Palatinate, *Amberger Rezeß*, 8 June 1593 (Reformed)	13, pp. 336–337	423	18.8.3, 18.9.3
Kurpfalz, *Mandat zur Institution und Polizeiordnung*, 16 August 1595 (Reformed)	19/2, p. 869	1169	18.5.4
Wild- and Rhinegraviate, *Patenordnung*, 1597	19/2, p. 574	1118	18.4.3, 18.5.1
Upper Palatinate, *Generalanweisung*, 20 March 1598 (Reformed)	13, p. 348	427	18.8.3

Franconia, Regensburg and Bavaria

Order	Sehling	Doc	§
Brandenburg-Nürnberg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1528	11, p. 138	269	18.5.3
Regensburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1567(?)	13, pp. 479, 483, 489	450	18.4.3, 18.9.1, 18.10.1
Regensburg, *Kirchenregimentsordnung*, 1572/1588	13, p. 509	452	18.6.3
Wolfstein, *Christliche Instructio* of Thomas Stieber, 1574	13, pp. 572, 580, 590–591	463	18.4.1, 18.5.3, 18.8.3

Württemberg, Hohenlohe and Swabia

Order	Sehling	Doc	§
Ulm, Konrad Sam's catechism, 1528/1536 (Moderate Reformed)	17/2, p. 108	834	18.6.1
Heilbronn, *Confessio Heilbronnensis* and *Kirchenordnung*, 1530	17/1, p. 286	770	18.9.1
Reutlingen, *Kirchenordnung*, c. 1531	17/2, p. 43	827	18.5.1
Ulm, *Handbüchlein*, 1531 (Moderate Reformed)	17/2, p. 176	838	18.9.1
Württemberg, *Visitationsordnung für die Superintendenten*, 1559	16, p. 387	683	18.3

Order	Sehling	Doc	§
Wimpfen, *Regelung der Predigtzeiten und Festtage beider Konfessionen*, 23 July 1568	17/2, pp. 519–521	928	18.8.3, 18.9.2, 18.9.3
Hohenlohe, *Kapitels- und Visitationsordnung*, 1579	15, pp. 369, 380	578	18.3, 18.5.2
Augsburg, *Einzelbestimmungen zu den Berufungsverhandlungen*, 1591	12, p. 115	342	18.8.3, 18.9.3
Schwäbisch Hall, *Kirchenordnung* 1543/1615, 1614/1615	17/1, pp. 123, 141	762	18.4.3, 18.5.3

Strasbourg, Alsace and Transylvania

Order	Sehling	Doc	§
Strasbourg, Wolfgang Capito's *Kinder bericht*, 1527 (Moderate Reformed)	20/1, p. 193	1285	18.6.1
Strasbourg, *Verbot, an anderen Orten die Messe zu hören*, 3 April 1531 (Moderate Reformed)	20/1, p. 224	1291	18.5.4
Rappoltstein, *Vergleich zwischen der deutschen und der französischen Gemeinde*, 28 May 1561 (Reformed)	20/2, pp. 100–103, 133	1370	18.11.4
Strasbourg, *Verbot der Konventikel und des auswärtigen Gottesdienstbesuchs*, 10 December 1597	20/1, p. 535	1343	18.5.4
Strasbourg, *Kirchenordnung*, 9 April 1598	20/1, pp. 557–558, 661–662	1344	18.7.1, 18.11.1
Strasbourg, *Stellungnahme des Magistrats … wegen der reformierten Taufpaten*, 28 March 1601	20/1, p. 700	1345	18.4.3
Hagenau, *Fundationsbrief*, 3 June 1614	20/2, p. 463	1405	18.9.3
Transylvanian Saxons, Honterus, *Reformationsbüchlein*, German version, 1543	24, p. 193	1666	18.4.1
Mediasch synod, 1578	24, p. 427	1707	18.4.1, 18.4.2, 18.9.3

Scripture index

This index lists the passages of Scripture that the book cites by book and chapter: in its own text, in the orders it quotes and in the translations. Each passage is followed by the sections that cite it, and each section number is a link. A section that cites a passage more than once is listed once, and a reference to a whole chapter is listed apart from references to its verses. A reference in the opening pages of a chapter, before its first section, is listed under the chapter.

Books are named and psalms numbered as in the Authorized Version, with the Apocrypha between the Testaments. Where an order numbers a psalm as the Vulgate does, as "the 42nd psalm" for *Iudica me*, the passage is listed under its English number. Texts named only by their titles, such as the Magnificat or the Aaronic blessing, are not indexed unless a chapter is given.

Old Testament: Genesis · Exodus · Leviticus · Numbers · Deuteronomy · 1 Samuel · 2 Kings · 2 Chronicles · Job · Psalms · Proverbs · Isaiah · Jeremiah · Ezekiel · Hosea

Apocrypha: Tobit · 2 Maccabees

New Testament: Matthew · Mark · Luke · John · Acts · Romans · 1 Corinthians · 2 Corinthians · Galatians · Ephesians · Philippians · Colossians · 1 Thessalonians · 1 Timothy · 2 Timothy · Titus · Hebrews · James · 1 Peter · 1 John · 2 John

Genesis

- 1 — 13.7.2, 13.15.1
- 1:27–28 — 13.7.1
- 1:31 — 13.7.1
- 2 — 13.7.2, 13.7.3
- 2:18 — 13.7.1
- 2:21–24 — 13.7.1
- 3 — 13.7.2
- 3:16–19 — 13.7.1
- 18 — 13.23.7

Exodus

- 18 — 13.13.1

Leviticus

- 12 — 13.5
- 19:26 — 13.20.3
- 20:6 — 13.20.3
- 26 — 13.15.5

Numbers

- 6 — 2.1, 2.3.2, 2.3.4, 2.5, 2.13.1, 2.13.2, 7.3.5, 7.11.4, 8.14.2, 10.10.3
- 6:24–26 — 7.14.8

Deuteronomy

- 16 — 13.13.1
- 17 — 13.16.4
- 18:10–11 — 13.20.3
- 18:11 — 13.20.2
- 28 — 13.15.5

1 Samuel

- 3:1 — 16.3.4

2 Kings

- 4 — 16.3.4
- 4:38 — 16.3.4

2 Chronicles

- 19 — 13.13.1

Job

- 19 — 10.9.5, 10.9.7
- 19:25–27 — 10.9.1, 10.9.5

Psalms

- 2 — 8.8.6
- 3 — 8.17.6
- 5:8 — 10.9.1
- 8 — 12.12.3
- 12 — 4.4.4, 8.1.1, 8.1.2, 8.5.2
- 14 — 4.4.4, 8.1.1, 8.5.2
- 16 — 12.12.3
- 19 — 13.17.1
- 20 — 8.16.7
- 22 — 12.12.3
- 23 — 8.14.6, 13.12.1
- 25:1–2 — 7.4.1
- 32:5 — 3.4.5
- 33:1–7 — 8.10.4
- 34:1–23 — 3.3.7
- 39 — 10.9.5
- 43 — 2.3.1, 3.1, 3.3.1, 3.3.2, 3.3.8, 3.4.1, 3.7, 7.15.1
- 43:4 — 3.3.2
- 51 — 2.5, 4.4.4, 8.1.1, 8.1.2, 8.4, 8.4.5, 8.4.7, 8.5.2, 8.5.3, 8.5.7, 8.8.5, 8.14.6, 8.19, 13.16.3
- 51:4 — 7.12.2
- 51:17 — 7.5.2
- 61 — 8.16.7
- 67 — 2.1, 2.3.2, 2.3.4, 2.13.2, 4.4.4, 7.3.5, 8.1.1, 8.1.2, 8.5.2, 8.5.7, 8.11.3, 8.15.6, 8.17.5, 8.19, 13.16.3
- 67:1 — 7.14.8
- 69 — 12.12.3
- 79 — 8.16.7
- 79:8 — 3.3.3, 3.6.2
- 79:8–9 — 3.3.3, 7.12.2, 7.15.1
- 84 — 3.6.1, 3.6.2, 13.14.3
- 85 — 3.6.1
- 86 — 3.6.1
- 90 — 10.9.5, 13.9.3
- 91 — 13.8.3
- 93 — 8.11.5
- 100 — 8.11.5
- 101 — 13.16.7
- 103 — 2.4.7, 2.5, 8.14.6
- 103:10 — 3.3.3, 7.15.1
- 104:30 — 3.3.1
- 106:6 — 7.12.2

- 110 — 12.12.3
- 111 — 2.4.1, 2.4.2, 2.5, 4.8.1, 8.1.1, 8.1.2, 8.3.4, 8.14, 8.14.1, 8.14.2, 8.14.6, 8.14.8, 8.15.1, 13.8.3
- 113 — 3.5.12, 3.5.13
- 115:1 — 3.3.8
- 116 — 3.6.1, 13.14.3
- 116:9 — 10.9.1
- 116:13 — 7.1.1, 7.2.6, 7.6.12, 7.7.2
- 117 — 8.11.5, 13.8.3
- 118:1 — 3.3.1
- 118:25 — 7.2.3
- 119 — 10.7.3, 10.13
- 121 — 8.11.5
- 121:8 — 13.3.3, 13.3.5
- 124 — 4.4.4, 8.1.1, 8.1.2, 8.5.2, 8.17, 8.17.6
- 124:8 — 3.1, 3.3.1, 3.3.4, 7.2.1, 7.9.2
- 125 — 13.8.3
- 127 — 8.1.2, 8.17, 8.17.2, 8.17.6, 13.5.2, 13.7.4
- 128 — 8.1.2, 8.17, 8.17.2, 8.19, 13.5.2, 13.7.2, 13.7.3
- 130 — 3.6.1, 3.6.2, 4.4.4, 8.1.1, 8.1.2, 8.5.2, 8.5.3, 8.5.7, 8.19, 13.8.3
- 148–150 — 3.6.3
- 150 — Chapter 3, 3.1, 3.6.3, 7.15.2

Proverbs

- 18 — 13.7.2
- 18:22 — 13.7.1

Isaiah

- 6 — 2.10.3, 8.12, 13.23.7
- 8:19 — 13.20.2
- 9 — 13.23.2
- 28 — 8.18.7
- 38:10–20 — 10.9.1, 10.9.5
- 40 — 4.5.1
- 49 — 15.10.1
- 49:23 — 15.10.1
- 53 — 2.4.7, 3.5.12, 4.1, 4.8.2, 4.11, 4.A.12, 4.A.16, 8.4.5
- 53:4f. — 3.5.14.2

Jeremiah

- 15 — 18.5.1
- 23:21 — 18.8.1

Ezekiel

- 3 — 18.5.1
- 33:11 — 3.5.11
- 37 — 10.9.5

Hosea

- 13:14 — 8.6.4.7

Tobit

- 3:3 — 3.3.3, 3.6.2

- 12:6 — 7.7.2

2 Maccabees

- 12:43–45 — 10.9.2

Matthew

- 1 — 13.23.2
- 2 — 12.5.3
- 2:10–11 — 8.6.4.7
- 3 — 12.8.9, 12.11.5, 13.23.7
- 3:16 — 8.6.4.7
- 6 — 7.1.2, 7.8.5
- 6:7 — 7.8.5
- 7 — 18.5.1
- 7:6 — 18.5.1
- 8:8 — 7.11.3
- 15 — 8.8.2
- 18 — 11.9.1, 13.1.1, 13.16, 13.16.4, 16.1, 16.6.1, 16.6.3, 16.10
- 18:15–17 — 13.16
- 18:15–18 — 16.6.1
- 18:19 — 6.5
- 19 — 13.7.2, 13.7.3, 13.7.10
- 24–25 — 13.21.5
- 27:46 — 3.5.10
- 28 — 13.10.5

Mark

- 10 — 13.3.3, 13.3.5, 13.3.7
- 10:13–16 — 13.3.2

Luke

- 1 — 8.16.5
- 1:35 — 7.14.4
- 1:39–56 — 12.8.2
- 2 — 13.23.2
- 7 — 12.8.8
- 7:36–50 — 12.8.8
- 10:5 — 13.20.2
- 11:1 — 7.8.5
- 17 — 7.4.3
- 22 — 7.14.7
- 22:17 — 7.2.6, 7.6.12, 13.22.5
- 22:19 — 7.3.2, 7.4.2

John

- 2 — 8.17.2, 13.7.4
- 3 — 3.3.6, 3.4.4, 6.18.R1.2, 13.8.3
- 3:16 — 3.4.4
- 3:35–36 — 3.3.6
- 5 — 13.9.1
- 6 — 3.5.6, 3.5.7, 7.8.1, 8.4.5, 8.9.2, 13.8.3
- 6:51 — 3.7

- 6:54 — 3.5.14.3
- 6:56 — 3.5.6, 3.5.14.3
- 8 — 3.5.13
- 11:25 — 10.9.5
- 11:25–26 — 10.9.1
- 12 — 10.9.5
- 13 — 13.23.4
- 14–18 — 2.4.7
- 14:27 — 7.7.2, 7.12.5
- 15:26–16:4 — 7.10
- 16:13 — 7.2.2
- 19:30 — 3.5.10
- 20 — 13.10.3
- 20:21–23 — 13.11.1
- 20:23 — 3.4.4, 3.5.14.2, 13.16.6

Acts

- 2:42 — 7.1.1
- 6 — 13.12.1, 13.19.1, 16.1, 16.3.3, 16.5, 16.5.2, 16.5.4, 16.6.3, 16.8, 16.10
- 6:1–6 — 16.5.3
- 6:2 — 16.5.3
- 6:3 — 16.5.3
- 6:6 — 16.5.3, 16.8
- 6:10 — 16.5.3
- 8:5 — 16.5.3
- 8:12 — 16.5.3
- 8:35 — 16.5.3
- 8:38 — 16.5.3
- 10:43 — 3.3.6
- 13 — 12.13.5
- 14 — 12.13.5, 16.6.2, 16.6.3
- 14:23 — 13.12.1, 16.1, 16.6.2
- 20 — 13.10, 13.10.4
- 20:28–31 — 13.10.2, 13.11.1, 13.12.1

Romans

- 1 — 2.4.3
- 4:25 — 3.5.5
- 5:10 — 3.5.14.2
- 5:19 — 4.A.5
- 6:23 — 3.5.6
- 11 — 13.21.6
- 11:33–36 — 7.10
- 12:1 — 7.1.1, 7.1.2, 7.5.1
- 13 — 13.13.1

1 Corinthians

- 1 — 3.5.13
- 5 — 13.16, 13.16.5
- 5:7 — 7.11.2
- 5:7f. — 3.5.14.4
- 7 — 13.7.10, 18.1.1, 18.10.2
- 10 — 3.5.6

- 10:12 — 13.16.5
- 10:16 — 2.4.7, 2.5, 7.1.1
- 10:17 — 3.5.10, 3.5.14.5
- 11 — 2.4.7, 2.5, 2.15.5, 3.5.10, 3.5.14.4, 7.1.1, 7.1.2, 7.5.2, 7.5.3, 7.7.2, 8.9.2, 13.8.2, 15.11.6, 16.9.2
- 11:23 — 7.8.3
- 11:23–29 — 3.5.10
- 11:24 — 7.5.1
- 11:25 — 7.3.2
- 11:26 — 3.7, 5.6.3, 5.6.4, 5.8
- 11:27 — 5.6.3, 5.8
- 11:27–29 — 7.5.2
- 11:28 — 3.5.1, 3.5.14.2, 15.1
- 11:28–29 — 15.11.6
- 12:28 — 16.6.3
- 14 — 8.18.7, 9.3.7, 12.11.1, 16.9.2, 16.10
- 14:34 — 16.1, 16.9.1, 16.9.2
- 15 — 10.9.5

2 Corinthians

- 3 — 13.21.6
- 13:13 — 2.13.2, 11.10.3

Galatians

- 2:9 — 17.7.4
- 5:20 — 13.20.4

Ephesians

- 4:7 — 13.10.3
- 5 — 8.17.2, 8.18.1, 13.7.2, 13.7.3
- 5:22–29 — 13.7.1
- 5:26 — 18.4.1

Philippians

- 1:1 — 16.5.3
- 2:8 — 8.6.4.7
- 2:10 — 2.15.4

Colossians

- 2 — 12.3.5

1 Thessalonians

- 4 — 10.9.5, 13.9, 13.9.1, 13.9.2
- 4:13 — 10.9.5
- 4:13–18 — 13.9.3
- 5 — 10.9.5

1 Timothy

- 1 — 3.3.6
- 2 — Introduction, 6.5, 6.11.G.3, 13.18.2, 16.9.2
- 2:1 — 6.1.4
- 2:1f. — 10.7.5
- 2:12 — 16.1, 16.9.1, 16.9.2

- 3 — 13.10, 13.10.3, 13.10.4, 13.10.5, 13.19.1, 15.3.3, 15.8.4, 16.1, 16.3.3, 16.5.2, 16.5.4
- 3:1 — 13.10.3
- 3:1–7 — 13.10.2, 13.11.1, 16.3.1
- 3:8 — 16.5.3
- 3:8f. — 16.5.3
- 3:8–12 — 16.5.3
- 3:10 — 13.12.1, 16.5.3
- 3:12 — 16.5.3
- 3:13 — 16.5.3
- 4 — 13.10.5, 13.15.1
- 4:4–5 — 13.15
- 5 — 16.6.1, 18.5.1
- 5:17 — 16.6
- 5:22 — 18.5.1
- 6 — 18.8.3

2 Timothy

- 3–4 — 13.10.5
- 3:16 — 11.6.2

Titus

- 1 — 13.10.5
- 1:5 — 16.6.5
- 1:7–9 — 16.3.1
- 3 — 13.13.1, 18.3, 18.10.1, 18.13
- 3:10 — 18.1.1

Hebrews

- 9:28 — 7.5.2
- 10:14 — 7.5.2
- 10:22 — 3.5.12
- 13:15 — 7.5.2

James

- 5 — 6.11.G.6, 13.1.1, 13.2.2, 13.8.1, 13.24
- 5:14–16 — 13.8.1

1 Peter

- 2 — 13.13.1
- 3:7 — 18.4.1
- 3:15 — 18.8.3
- 5 — 13.10.3
- 5:2–4 — 13.10.2

1 John

- 2:1–2 — 3.3.6
- 4:9 — 3.5.14.2

2 John

- 1 — 18.3, 18.10.1, 18.13
- 1:10–11 — 18.1.1, 18.3, 18.8.3

Index of persons

This index lists the historical persons whom the book names: the reformers, princes, prelates, pastors, schoolmasters and musicians of the period, in the orders it quotes, in Sehling's titles of them and in its own text, and the Fathers and other persons of earlier centuries. Each person is followed by the sections that name them, and each section number is a link. A section that names a person more than once is listed once. A person named in the opening pages of a chapter, before its first section, is listed under the chapter.

Biblical persons, saints named for their feast days, and later editors and scholars are not indexed. Rulers are as a rule entered under their first names, with title and territory, as "August, Elector of Saxony", and others under their surnames. Each person is listed under one heading, whatever form of the name the text uses: "Doctor Martinus" is listed under Luther and "Pomeranus" under Bugenhagen.

A · B · C · D · E · F · G · H · I · J · K · L · M · N · O · P · Q · R · S · T · U · V · W · Z

A

- Abel, Konrad — 1.20.2
- Adolf, Count of Neuenahr and Moers — 1.33.3, 6.18
- Adolf I, Duke of Holstein-Gottorp — 1.34.1
- Aepinus, Johannes — 3.3.2
- Albrecht, Duke in Prussia — 1.10.3, 14.7.4, 18.1.1, 18.11.2
- Albrecht Alcibiades, Margrave of Brandenburg-Kulmbach — 13.14.3
- Ambrose — 9.5.5, 10.7.3, 16.6.1, 16.6.2, 17.12.4
- Amsdorf, Nikolaus von — 8.17.4, 8.19
- Andreae, Jakob — 1.31.7, 6.14, 13.4.4, 13.19.1, 17.13, 17.13.3, 18.4.3, 18.13
- Anna, Countess of East Frisia — 1.1, 1.3.3, 1.13.7
- Anton I, Count of Oldenburg — 6.14
- Assum, Johann — 11.8.3, 11.14
- Athanasius — 16.9.7
- August, Elector of Saxony — 1.6.2, 1.6.4, 2.5, 4.12, 5.6.4, 5.8, 5.9, 6.6, 10.5.3, 10.14, 11.7.2, 11.7.5, 11.8.2, 11.9.2, 11.14, 12.12.3, 12.13.6, 12.16, 13.3.8, 13.6.7, 13.8.3, 13.9.2, 13.11.1, 13.15.5, 13.17.1, 13.24, 13.25, 14.5.7, 14.10, 16.3.3, 16.5.1, 16.7.1, 16.11, 17.5.3, 17.17.1, 17.18, 17.19, 18.4.3, 18.13, 18.14
- Augustine — 3.5.6, 9.5.5, 12.13.6, 13.4.1, 13.6.3, 13.12.8, 15.1, 15.2.1, 15.11.6, 17.12.4

B

- Babst, Valentin — 10.11.3
- Bader, Johannes — 1.28.1
- Banc, Arnaud — 1.31.3, 15.11.6, 15.13, 18.11.4
- Barnim IX, Duke of Pomerania — 1.9.4
- Bernhard, Prince of Anhalt — 1.7.13, 12.4.5, 12.7.1, 12.10.6, 12.16, 14.7.4, 14.9, 14.10
- Beust, Joachim von — 15.11.5
- Beza, Theodore — 16.1, 16.6.3, 18.1.1, 18.5.4, 18.12, 18.13
- Bidembach, Felix — 15.11.5, 18.4.3, 18.5.3
- Bieberstein, Abraham von — 1.8.5
- Bieberstein, Joachim von — 1.8.5
- Bieberstein, Johann von — 1.8.5
- Blarer, Ambrosius — 1.3.3, 1.25.3, 1.26.2, 1.26.3
- Bode, Michael — 16.5.2
- Bonnus, Hermann — 1.13.5, 6.12, 10.1, 10.4.2, 10.6.2, 10.7.1, 10.7.5, 10.8.1, 10.9.4, 10.9.7, 10.13, 10.14
- Bora, Katharina von — 10.4.4
- Brenz, Johannes — Introduction, 1.5, 1.26.4, 2.15.3, 6.1.4, 6.3, 6.4, 6.5, 6.6, 8.7.3, 8.14.7, 8.19, 10.1, 10.9.1, 10.9.6, 10.10.5, 11.8.2, 12.2.3, 12.3.5, 12.7.3, 12.16, 13.3.5, 14.1, 14.7.2, 14.9, 15.11.6, 17.13
- Bucanus, Wilhelm — 15.7.4

- Bucer, Martin — Conventions, Chapter 1, 1.1, 1.2.5, 1.3.3, 1.16.1, 1.26.2, 1.30.1, 1.33.1, 6.1.4, 7.5, 7.5.3, 13.6.2, 13.6.6, 14.4.4, 16.6, 16.6.2, 17.17.1
- Buchholtzer, Georg — 1.8.6
- Bugenhagen, Johannes — Introduction, 1.6.6, 1.11.2, 2.1, 2.4.2, 2.5, 2.6.3, 2.8, 2.9.1, 2.9.4, 2.13.1, 2.15.3, Chapter 3, 3.1, 3.3.1, 3.3.3, 3.4.1, 3.4.2, 3.4.3, 3.4.4, 3.5.1, 3.5.2, 3.5.4, 3.5.7, 3.5.14.5, 3.6.2, 3.6.3, 3.7, 3.8, 4.1, 4.6.1, 4.7.3, 4.8.2, 4.10.2, 6.3, 6.12, Chapter 7, 7.1, 7.1.1, 7.1.2, 7.1.3, 7.3.6, 7.15, 7.15.1, 7.15.2, 7.15.3, 7.15.4, 8.1.1, 8.1.3, 8.3.4, 8.4.1, 8.4.3, 8.4.6, 8.6.3, 8.7.1, 8.7.3, 8.9.2, 8.9.5, 8.10.2, 8.12, 8.14.3, 8.14.4, 8.14.6, 8.15.1, 8.16.3, 8.18.2, 8.18.7, 8.19, 10.1, 10.4.3, 10.5.1, 10.5.2, 10.7.1, 10.7.3, 10.7.5, 10.8.1, 10.8.3, 10.9.2, 10.11.1, 10.12.2, 12.1.1, 12.3.3, 12.5.4, 12.7, 12.8.9, 12.9.1, 12.11.5, 12.12.5, 12.16, 13.4.2, 13.10.2, 13.10.3, 13.11.4, 13.15.3, 13.19.1, 13.20.1, 13.22.4, 13.23.4, 14.4.1, 14.9, 16.1, 16.2, 16.3.3, 16.5.2, 16.5.4, 16.9.4, 16.10, 16.11, 18.1.1, 18.6.1
- Burck, Joachim a — 8.16.9

C

- Calvin, John — Introduction, 6.3, 6.20, 17.7.3, 18.1.2, 18.7.3, 18.12, 18.13
- Capito, Wolfgang — 1.3.3, 1.30.1, 3.5.13, 7.5, 18.1.1, 18.6.1, 18.12, 18.13, 18.14
- Casimir, Margrave of Brandenburg-Kulmbach — 1.19.2
- Charles V, Emperor — 17.6.1, 17.6.3, 17.6.4, 17.6.6, 17.7.3, 17.8.1, 17.9.3, 17.9.5, 17.10.3, 17.10.4, 17.12.1, 17.12.3, 17.12.4, 17.13.3, 17.13.5, 17.14.1, 17.16, 17.17.5
- Chemnitz, Martin — 1.11.2, 6.14, 17.9, 17.9.3, 18.4.1, 18.7.1, 18.7.3
- Christian I, Elector of Saxony — 13.4.4
- Christoph, Archbishop of Bremen — 1.15.3
- Christoph, Duke of Württemberg — 13.12.9, 16.7.4, 16.9.2, 17.13.1
- Chrysostom, John — 12.3.6
- Clemens non Papa, Jacobus — 4.1, 4.9.2, 4.10.4, 4.11
- Codomann, Laurentius — 13.14.3
- Coelius, Michael — 5.1, 5.4.4, 5.8
- Corvinus, Antonius — 1.12.3, 1.32.6, 4.8.3, 4.12, 5.4.4, 5.9, 6.16, 7.1.3, 7.13, 7.15.1, 7.15.2, 8.11.3, 8.19, 11.1, 11.8.1, 11.13
- Cox, Richard — 1.3.4
- Cyprian — 15.1, 15.2.1, 15.11.6

D

- Daser, Ludwig — 4.10.4
- Decius, Nikolaus — 2.7.2, 7.1.2, 7.13.3, 8.1.1, 8.7, 8.7.4, 8.12, 8.12.2, 8.15
- Dietrich, Heinrich — 18.7.1
- Dietrich, Veit — Introduction, 1.19.5, 3.3.2, 3.3.8, 3.4.4, 3.5.2, 3.5.5, 3.7, 3.8, 4.3.1, 4.11, 4.12, 5.1, 5.4.4, 5.7, 5.8, 6.4, 6.8, 8.10.3, 8.14.6, 8.19, 10.1, 10.7.1, 10.8.2, 10.9.1, 10.10.2, 10.10.5, 10.14, 12.6.4, 12.8.3, 12.16, 13.1.2, 13.4.1, 13.8.3, 13.8.4, 13.8.6, 13.9.1, 13.17.1, 13.18.4, 13.21.2, 13.22.5, 13.24, 13.25, 14.1, 14.4.5, 14.9, 14.10, 16.7.1, 16.9.2, 16.9.9, 16.10, 16.11
- Döber, Andreas — 1.19.1, 2.1, 2.4.8, 2.10.3, 2.13.2, 2.15.7, 2.15.10, 2.16, Chapter 3, 3.1, 3.2, 3.3.1, 3.3.2, 3.3.4, 3.3.5, 3.3.7, 3.4.1, 3.4.2, 3.4.3, 3.4.4, 3.4.5, 3.5.1, 3.5.2, 3.5.4, 3.5.5, 3.7, 3.8, 4.2, 4.A, 4.A.16, 5.1, 5.5.2, 5.6.4, 5.7, 5.8, 5.9, 5.A, Chapter 7, 7.1.1, 7.1.2, 7.3.2, 7.5, 7.5.1, 7.7, 7.7.1, 7.7.2, 7.8, 7.8.2, 7.8.7, 7.8.11, 7.11, 7.11.3, 7.15.4, 8.5.3, 8.19
- Döberlein, Wolfgang — 13.14.3
- Dressler, Gallus — 4.10.4, 13.14.3

E

- Eber, Paul — 8.A.2
- Eberhard, Leonhard — 13.14.3
- Edward VI, King of England — 1.3.4
- Edzard II, Count of East Frisia — 17.10.6
- Egenolph IV, Lord of Rappoltstein — 18.11.4
- Eitzen, Paul von — 1.34.1, 17.8.4
- Elisabeth, Duchess of Brunswick-Calenberg — 1.12.1, 6.16, 7.13, 13.6.3
- Enno II, Count of East Frisia — 1.13.7
- Epiphanius — 16.9.2

- Erastus, Thomas — 16.1, 16.6.3
- Ernst, Count of Holstein-Schaumburg — 6.18
- Ernst, Duke of Brunswick-Lüneburg — 1.11.3

F

- Faber, Gellius — 3.5.14.4
- Faber (preacher at Amberg) — 1.21.2
- Fabricius, Jakob — 1.34.1
- Fabricius (superintendent in Anhalt) — 1.7.13
- Fagius, Paul — 1.25.4
- Ferdinand I, Emperor — 1.26.5
- Flavian, Patriarch of Constantinople — 17.3.1, 17.11.1
- Forster, Georg — 13.14.3
- François, Nicolas — 1.31.3
- Frederick I, King of Denmark — 1.34.1
- Friedrich II, Duke of Liegnitz — 1.8.6
- Friedrich II, Elector Palatine — 1.22.1
- Friedrich III, Elector Palatine — 1.21.2, 1.22.1, 3.3.6, 3.5.10, 6.18, 6.18.R1.5, 6.19, 14.4.4
- Friedrich IV, Elector Palatine — 1.22.1, 1.29.2, 15.10.2, 15.11.4, 16.6.3, 17.12

G

- Galliculus, Johannes — 4.10.4
- Gallus, Nikolaus — 1.21.3, 13.10.4, 14.7.3, 16.4.3
- Georg, Count of Erbach — 6.8
- Georg, Duke of Pfalz-Simmern — 16.7.4
- Georg, Margrave of Brandenburg-Ansbach — 1.19.2, 9.4.1, 17.14.1
- Georg I, Landgrave of Hesse-Darmstadt — 1.16.2
- Georg II, Duke of Brieg — 1.8.6
- Georg III, Prince of Anhalt — 1.7.13, 8.11.4, 13.10.3, 13.11.4, 13.25
- Georg Ernst, Count of Henneberg — 1.7.9, 3.5.3, 3.8, 5.4.2, 5.9, 6.8, 10.12.7, 10.14, 11.14, 12.2.3, 12.6.3, 13.2.3, 13.4.3, 13.25, 17.6.2, 17.18, 17.19, 18.5.2, 18.13, 18.14
- Georg Friedrich, Count of Hohenlohe — 13.14.2
- Georg Johann, Count Palatine of Veldenz — 6.5, 6.6
- Geschmus, Augustin — 10.9.3, 10.9.7
- Gesius, Bartholomäus — 8.A.1
- Geyer, Hans — 13.12.2
- Goltz, Joachim — 1.8.4
- Görlitz, Martin — 7.15.1
- Gotthard Kettler, Duke of Courland — 1.10.3
- Gottwald, Andreas — 18.5.4
- Gregory I, Pope — 2.6.1, 14.4.1, 14.4.4
- Greiter, Matthäus — 2.9.4

H

- Hagemann, Simon — 1.33.5
- Hamelmann, Hermann — 17.10.4
- Hanssen, Paul — 1.13.9, 9.4.2
- Hardenberg, Albert — 1.3.3, 1.15.3
- Hausmann, Nicolaus — 1.7.3, 12.4.6, 12.5.7, 12.6.1, 12.8.1, 12.8.3, 12.8.4, 12.16, 13.23.2, 13.25
- Hefentreger, Johann — 1.17.2
- Hegenwalt, Erhart — 8.4.5
- Heinrich, Archbishop of Bremen — 1.13.1

- Heinrich, Duke of Saxony — 1.5, 1.6.3, 1.6.4, 1.6.5, 2.4.1, 2.5, 2.6.1, 2.9.1, 2.10.1, 2.10.2, 2.11, 2.12.1, 2.13.2, 4.1, 4.3.3, 4.4.2, 4.8.1, 4.8.4, 4.11, 4.12, 5.4.2, 5.8, 5.9, 10.14, 12.3.7, 13.3.3, 13.3.4, 13.4.4, 13.8.3, 13.9.2
- Heinrich IV, Count of Sayn — 6.6
- Heinrich IV, Lord of Reuss — 1.7.6, 5.9, 8.11.1, 8.19, 9.5.6, 9.7, 18.8.2, 18.13, 18.14
- Heinrich Julius, Duke of Brunswick-Wolfenbüttel — 13.19.1
- Hemmingsen, Niels — 15.11.5
- Hertweg, Georg — 13.12.3, 13.14.3
- Heshusen, Tilemann — 1.14.2, 1.15.2, 13.10.3, 13.11.4, 15.11.5
- Heyden, Sebald — 8.14, 8.14.6
- Hiemeyer, David — 13.14.2
- Hofmann, Johann — 3.5.14.5, 13.14.2
- Hollande, Johannes de — 13.14.3
- Homer — 12.3.4
- Honterus, Johannes — 7.1.3, 8.8.1, 8.19, 12.3.7, 12.16, 16.9.1, 16.9.5, 16.10, 16.11, 18.1.1, 18.4.1, 18.4.2, 18.13, 18.14
- Huberinus, Caspar — 1.23.1, 3.7, 6.3, 6.13
- Hügel, Andreas — 18.7.2, 18.13
- Hus, John — 8.1.1, 8.1.3, 8.3.2, 8.13.2, 8.14, 8.14.1, 8.14.2, 8.14.6, 8.14.8, 8.19

I

- Isaac, Heinrich — 4.1, 4.10.4

J

- Janken (brother of Paul Hanssen) — 9.4.2
- Joachim, Prince of Anhalt — 1.7.13
- Joachim II, Elector of Brandenburg — 1.8.1, 4.12, 5.9, 6.16, Chapter 7, 7.12, 10.4.2, 10.9.5, 10.14, 12.5.7, 13.3.2, 13.6.4, 13.15.2, 13.17.3, 13.18.2, 13.18.4, 13.23.3, 13.25, 16.4.1, 16.11
- Joachim Ernst, Prince of Anhalt — 17.6.6
- Joachim Friedrich, Duke of Liegnitz and Brieg — 1.8.6
- Johann, Elector of Saxony — 1.6.3, 17.6.1
- Johann, Margrave of Brandenburg-Küstrin — 1.8.1, 12.9.3
- Johann I, Count Palatine of Zweibrücken — 17.12.4
- Johann III, Duke of Jülich-Cleves-Berg — 1.3.6
- Johann IV, Prince of Anhalt — 1.7.13, 8.11.4
- Johann VI, Count of Nassau-Dillenburg — 1.18.1, 13.12.7, 13.20.6
- Johann Adolf, Duke of Holstein-Gottorp — 11.9.3, 17.8.4
- Johann Albrecht, Count of Solms-Braunfels — 16.6.3
- Johann Albrecht I, Duke of Mecklenburg — 14.6.6
- Johann Casimir, Count Palatine — Conventions, 1.22.1, 1.29.4, 11.9.3, 13.12.4, 13.13.3, 14.1, 17.12, 17.12.1, 17.12.2, 18.5.4
- Johann Friedrich, Archbishop of Bremen — 1.13.1
- Johann Friedrich I, Elector of Saxony — 17.6.1, 18.13
- Johann Friedrich II, Duke of Saxony — 1.6.2, 11.12.2, 15.5.2, 17.6.1, 17.19
- Johann Friedrich III, Duke of Saxony — 11.12.2, 17.6.1, 17.19
- Johann Georg, Prince of Anhalt — 1.3.3, 1.7.13, 12.15, 12.16, 14.5.2, 14.9, 14.10
- Johann the Elder, Duke of Schleswig-Holstein — 14.5.7
- Johann Wilhelm, Duke of Saxony — 1.6.3, 11.12.2, 17.6.1, 17.19
- Jonas, Justus — 1.7.8, 1.7.13, 1.21.3, 3.3.2, 3.8, 4.12, 8.8.9, 8.16.1, 8.17.6, 8.18.5, 8.19, 9.3.3, 9.6, 9.7, 10.14, 13.21.3, 14.6.3, 14.9, 14.10, 16.4.2, 16.10, 16.11
- Joris, David — 1.34.1
- Josquin des Prez — 4.1, 4.10.4
- Judex, Johannes — 17.10.4
- Julius, Duke of Brunswick-Wolfenbüttel — 4.12, 4.A.1, 6.14, 17.9.1, 17.19
- Justin Martyr — 6.1.1, 6.11

K

- Kantz, Kaspar — 1.20.7, 2.4.8, 2.10.3, 2.12.1, Chapter 3, 3.1, 3.3.1, 3.3.2, 3.3.4, 3.3.5, 3.3.7, 3.4.1, 3.4.3, 3.4.4, 3.5.1, 3.5.2, 3.5.14.1, 3.5.14.2, 3.6.3, 3.7, 4.2, 4.A, 4.A.16, 5.6.4, Chapter 7, 7.1, 7.1.1, 7.1.2, 7.2, 7.2.4, 7.2.6, 7.2.7, 7.3.3, 7.4.4, 7.7.2, 7.9, 7.9.2, 7.9.3, 7.9.4, 7.10, 7.11, 7.11.1
- Karl I, Count Palatine of Birkenfeld — 17.12.5
- Karlstadt, Andreas — 1.6.6, 14.1, 14.5.2
- Kefelius, Pancratius — 18.4.3
- Kestner, Veit — 1.23.1
- Keuchenthal, Johannes — 8.A.1
- Knox, John — 1.3.4
- Kolb, Franz — 3.3.6, 3.7, 3.8
- Kolowrat, Jaroslaw von — 1.8.5
- Kosch, Laurentius — 17.16
- Kreuziger, Elisabeth — 8.18.5
- Kroschen, Severus — 1.14.2, 13.12.3, 13.25

L

- Lambert, Francis — 16.3.2
- Lasco, John a — Introduction, Conventions, Chapter 1, 1.3.3, 1.3.4, 1.13.7, 1.13.9, 2.15.3, 3.4.4, 3.5.10, 6.3, 6.21, 7.1.1, 7.1.3, 16.6.2
- Lassus, Orlande de — 4.1, 4.10.4, 4.11, 8.16.9, 13.14.3
- Lauterbach, Anton — 1.6.6, 8.8.7, 8.19, 10.9.5, 10.14
- Lehmann, Anna (widow of Georg Lehmann) — 16.9.4
- Leo I, Pope — 17.3.1, 17.11.1, 17.18
- Leyden, Peter van — 16.5.2
- Leyser, Polycarp — 13.4.1
- Linck, Wenzel — 3.4.4
- Lobwasser, Ambrosius — 8.1.3, 8.10.4, 8.11.5, 8.14.6, 8.16.7, 8.19
- Löner, Kaspar — 1.20.7, 3.3.2, 3.5.8, 3.8, 8.4.1, 8.7.4, 8.10.1, 8.11.4, 8.19, 9.3.3, 11.10.2, 13.12.6, 13.25, 14.5.6, 14.9, 14.10, 16.7.3, 16.10, 16.11
- Lorenz (schoolmaster at Frankfurt) — 16.5.2
- Lossius, Lucas — 2.10.1, 4.1, 4.8.4, 4.10.1, 4.11, 8.1.1, 8.1.3, 8.6, 8.6.4.7, 8.7.5, 8.8.6, 8.16.1, 8.16.8, 8.18.6, 8.19, 10.1, 10.2, 10.11.2, 10.11.4, 10.13, 12.4.2, 12.4.6
- Ludecus, Matthäus — Introduction, 8.A.1, 8.A.4
- Ludwig, Duke of Württemberg — 17.13.2
- Ludwig IV, Landgrave of Hesse-Marburg — 1.16.2
- Ludwig VI, Elector Palatine — Conventions, 1.21.2, 1.22.1, 1.29.4, 13.12.4, 14.1, 14.6.3, 14.7.4, 17.12, 17.12.1, 18.5.4
- Ludwig Casimir, Count of Hohenlohe — 1.23.1
- Luther, Martin — Introduction, Conventions, 1.3.6, 1.5, 1.6, 1.6.1, 1.6.3, 1.7.8, 1.8.5, 1.15.3, Chapter 2, 2.1, 2.3, 2.3.2, 2.3.3, 2.5, 2.6.1, 2.9.2, 2.9.4, 2.10.3, 2.12.1, 2.13.1, 2.13.2, 2.15.2, 2.15.9, 2.16, 3.1, 3.3.1, 3.3.6, 3.3.7, 3.5.1, 3.5.2, 3.5.3, 3.5.4, 3.5.6, 3.5.7, 3.5.14.5, 3.6.2, 3.6.3, 3.6.4, 3.6.5, 3.7, 3.8, 4.1, 4.3.1, 4.3.3, 4.4.1, 4.5.3, 4.6.1, 4.6.2, 4.7.1, 4.8.1, 4.9.1, 4.10.2, 4.10.3, 4.11, 4.12, 4.A.1, 4.A.16, Chapter 5, 5.1, 5.3, 5.3.2, 5.3.3, 5.4.1, 5.4.3, 5.4.4, 5.4.5, 5.5.1, 5.6.1, 5.6.2, 5.6.3, 5.6.4, 5.6.6, 5.7, 5.8, 5.9, 5.A, Chapter 7, 7.1.1, 7.1.2, 7.1.3, 7.3, 7.3.2, 7.3.5, 7.3.6, 7.4.3, 7.5.1, 7.6.11, 7.7.1, 7.7.2, 7.8, 7.8.2, 7.10, 7.11, 7.11.2, 7.13.1, 7.14.3, 7.14.7, 7.15, 7.15.1, 8.1.1, 8.1.3, 8.2.1, 8.3.2, 8.3.3, 8.4.1, 8.4.2, 8.4.3, 8.4.7, 8.5, 8.5.2, 8.5.4, 8.6.1, 8.7, 8.7.4, 8.8, 8.8.1, 8.8.2, 8.8.3, 8.8.5, 8.8.7, 8.9, 8.9.1, 8.10.1, 8.10.3, 8.11, 8.12, 8.12.1, 8.12.2, 8.12.5, 8.13, 8.13.1, 8.14, 8.14.1, 8.15, 8.15.2, 8.16.8, 8.16.9, 8.17.1, 8.17.2, 8.17.4, 8.17.5, 8.18.4, 8.18.5, 8.18.6, 8.19, 8.A.2, 8.A.4, 9.1, 9.3.1, 9.5.5, 9.6, 9.7, Chapter 10, 10.1, 10.3, 10.3.1, 10.3.2, 10.3.3, 10.4.1, 10.5.2, 10.6.4, 10.7.1, 10.7.5, 10.8.1, 10.8.3, 10.9.2, 10.10.1, 10.10.3, 10.10.4, 10.10.5, 10.11.2, 10.11.3, 10.11.4, 10.12.3, 10.12.8, 10.13, 10.14, Chapter 11, 11.1, 11.3, 11.3.1, 11.3.2, 11.4.3, 11.4.4, 11.5.1, 11.5.2, 11.8.1, 11.8.2, 11.11.2, 11.13, 11.14, 12.1.1, 12.3.1, 12.4.3, 12.4.5, 12.7.3, 12.8.1, 12.8.9, 12.10.11, 12.12, 12.12.1, 12.15, 12.16, 13.1.1, 13.1.2, 13.3, 13.3.1, 13.3.2, 13.3.3, 13.3.4, 13.3.5, 13.3.9, 13.4.1, 13.4.4, 13.6.1, 13.6.5, 13.7, 13.7.1, 13.7.2, 13.7.4, 13.7.8, 13.10.2, 13.10.3, 13.10.5, 13.11.1, 13.12.3, 13.15.4, 13.17.2, 13.21, 13.21.2, 13.21.3, 13.23.1, 13.23.4, 13.23.7, 13.24, 13.25, 14.1, 14.3.3, 14.4.1, 14.6.6, 14.9, 15.1, 15.3.2, 15.8.2, 15.8.3, 15.11.5, 16.1, 16.4.4, 16.9.9, 16.10, 16.11, Chapter 17, 17.1.1, 17.2.1, 17.3.2, 17.3.4, 17.3.5, 17.5.1, 17.5.3, 17.6.1, 17.6.2, 17.6.3, 17.6.4, 17.6.5, 17.6.6, 17.7.1, 17.7.2, 17.7.3, 17.7.4, 17.8.1, 17.8.3, 17.8.4, 17.9, 17.9.1, 17.9.2, 17.9.3, 17.9.4, 17.9.5, 17.10.2, 17.10.3, 17.10.4, 17.10.6, 17.10.7, 17.11, 17.11.1, 17.11.2, 17.11.3, 17.11.5, 17.12, 17.12.1, 17.12.3, 17.13.2, 17.14.1, 17.14.3, 17.17.5, 17.18, 18.1.1, 18.5.3, 18.7.2, 18.12, 18.13

M

- Magnus, Johann Georg — 18.8.3
- Mandelsloh, Agnese von — 16.9.4
- Marbach, Johann — Conventions, 1.22.1, 1.30.1, 2.13.2, 3.5.2, 3.5.5, 13.6.6, 13.10.5, 16.1, 16.6.1, 16.10, 16.11, 17.17.1, 17.18, 17.19, 18.11.4
- Marboeuf, Pierre — 1.31.3
- Maria, Lady of Jever — 1.14.4
- Marquard, Bishop of Speyer — 1.22.1
- Mathesius, Johannes — 11.4.6, 11.8.2, 11.13
- Maximilian II, Emperor — 1.26.7, 1.31.7
- Meiland, Jakob — 4.10.4
- Melanchthon, Philip — Conventions, Chapter 1, 1.2.5, 1.3.3, 1.15.3, 1.33.1, 6.3, 6.9, 10.11.2, 11.8.2, 13.6.1, 13.10.2, 15.1, 15.3.2, 15.10.1, 16.1, 16.5.4, Chapter 17, 17.1.1, 17.3.3, 17.3.4, 17.5, 17.5.1, 17.5.2, 17.7.1, 17.7.4, 17.8.1, 17.8.2, 17.10.4, 17.10.5, 17.11, 17.11.1, 17.11.4, 17.12.5, 17.13.1, 17.13.3, 17.14.1
- Mening, Markus — 1.15.3, 17.10.5, 17.18
- Micron, Marten — 1.3.4, 1.13.9, 3.1, 3.3.6, 3.4.3, 3.4.4, 3.5.1, 3.5.2, 3.5.10, 3.5.14.4, 3.6.5, 3.7, 3.8, 6.3, 6.21, 9.1, 9.3.1, 9.5.4, 9.6, 9.7, 10.10.2, 10.10.6, 10.10.7, 10.14, 12.13.5, 12.16, 13.1.1, 13.1.2, 13.12.1, 13.16, 13.16.7, 13.24, 13.25, 14.6.7, 15.11.2, 16.1, 16.2, 16.5.3, 16.5.4, 16.6.3, 16.8, 16.9.1, 16.9.3, 16.9.7, 16.9.8, 16.10, 16.11, 17.17.1, 17.18, 17.19
- Minkwitz, Hans von — 1.8.5
- Mögner, Veit — 8.18.5
- Moritz, Elector of Saxony — 1.6.4, 1.6.6, 1.7.1
- Moritz, Landgrave of Hesse-Kassel — 1.17.1
- Mörlin, Joachim — 1.11.2, 17.9, 18.7.3
- Muhammad (Mahomet) — 6.13.I.1
- Müntzer, Thomas — Conventions, Chapter 1, 1.1, 1.2.5, 1.3.1, 1.3.6, 1.6.6, 2.1, 2.4.8, 2.6.1, 2.12.1, 2.13.1, 2.15.2, 2.15.4, 2.15.6, 2.15.7, 3.1, 3.3.1, 3.3.8, 3.4.1, 3.7, 3.8, 4.1, 4.2, 4.3.2, 4.4.4, 4.5.2, 4.6.3, 4.7.2, 4.8.2, 4.8.3, 4.9.1, 4.10.2, 4.10.3, 4.11, 4.12, 4.A.2, 4.A.5, 4.A.6, 4.A.8, 4.A.10, 4.A.16, 5.1, 5.5.2, 5.6.2, 5.6.6, 5.7, 5.8, 5.9, 5.A, Chapter 7, 7.1.1, 7.1.2, 7.3.3, 7.4, 7.4.1, 7.4.3, 7.4.4, 7.10, 7.11, 7.11.2, 7.11.4, 7.13, 7.13.1, 7.13.4, 8.16.8, 8.19, 9.5.2, 9.5.3, 13.2.3, 13.9.1, 14.1, 14.5.2, 14.7.1
- Musculus, Andreas — 16.9.4

N

- Naso, Joseph — 1.15.3, 17.18
- Nasserus, Bartholomaeus — 18.4.3
- Nervius, Johannes — 1.31.8
- Nieden, Arnd van — 16.5.2
- Nimwegen, Rudolf von — 7.11
- Noppus, Hieronymus — 1.21.3, 8.16.7, 8.17.3, 8.19, 16.7.3, 16.10, 16.11

O

- Oecolampadius, Johannes — 1.26.2, 3.5.12
- Origen — 18.7.3
- Osiander, Andreas — 3.1, 3.4.4, 3.5.1, 3.5.2, 3.5.4, 3.5.5, 3.5.7, 3.5.14.3, 3.7, 4.11, 5.5.2, 5.8, 6.16, 7.1.1, 7.1.2, 7.8.7, 7.12.6, 7.14, 7.14.2, 7.A, 13.22.3
- Ottheinrich, Elector Palatine — 1.21.2, 1.22.1, 2.4.5, 4.8.2, 4.12, 6.5, 6.6, 6.16, 7.14, 10.14, 12.10.3, 12.16, 13.3.2, 13.15.4, 13.17.2, 13.25, 17.12, 17.12.1, 17.18, 17.19

P

- Pangratius, Andreas — 13.14.3, 14.6.7
- Pappus, Johannes — 18.4.3
- Pauli, Simon — 1.10.4
- Pfeffinger, Johann — 4.12, 6.3, 6.9, 10.12.7, 10.14, 14.5.5, 14.10, 16.11
- Pflacher, Moses — 1.21.4

- Philipp, Landgrave of Hesse — Conventions, Chapter 1, 1.1, 1.2.5, 1.3.3, 1.5, 1.16.1, 6.1.4, 6.11, 11.2, 12.3.2, 17.11
- Philipp I, Count of Leiningen-Westerburg — 6.5
- Philipp I, Duke of Brunswick-Grubenhagen — 1.12.6, 18.7.1, 18.13
- Philipp I, Margrave of Baden — 12.13.3, 12.16
- Philipp II, Duke of Brunswick-Grubenhagen — 1.12.5
- Philipp II, Landgrave of Hesse-Rheinfels — 1.16.2
- Philipp II, Margrave of Baden — 1.22.1
- Philipp IV, Count of Hanau-Lichtenberg — 6.7
- Pistorius, Johannes — 1.34.1
- Plateanus, Petrus — 16.9.9
- Platina, Bartolomeo — 2.6.1
- Plauen, Anna von, Abbess of Gernrode — 1.7.13
- Porta, Conrad — 15.11.5, 18.5.3
- Poullain, Valérand — 1.17.6, 3.3.1, 3.3.6, 3.4.3, 6.20, 18.11.4
- Promnitz, Abraham von — 1.8.6
- Prudentius — 10.7.3
- Püttner, David — 1.23.1

Q

- Queiss, Erhard von, Bishop of Pomesania — 13.15.1

R

- Rabus, Ludwig — 1.26.2
- Rantzau, Heinrich — 1.34.1
- Reichard, Duke of Pfalz-Simmern — 1.22.1, 1.29.2
- Reysing, Philipp — 13.12.2
- Rhau, Georg — 4.10.4, 8.12.2
- Rhegius, Urbanus — 1.5, 1.11.4, 1.12.4, 1.20.1, 3.5.14.2, 12.13.2
- Rodtbart, Petrus — 1.14.4
- Rothmann, Bernhard — Conventions, Chapter 1, 1.1, 1.3.3, 1.33.6
- Runge, Jacob — 13.11.4
- Ruprecht, Wolfgang — 16.9.6

S

- Sahr, Johann — 13.14.3
- Sam, Konrad — 1.26.2, 18.6.1, 18.13, 18.14
- Sarcerius, Erasmus — 1.7.8, 13.3.8, 13.10.2, 15.11.5
- Schaumberg, Hans Paul von — 13.14.3
- Schenk, Jacob — 1.6.5, 10.14, 16.3.3, 16.11
- Schlemmer, Jakob — 13.14.3
- Schlüter, Gottfried — 17.10.4, 17.19
- Schnabel, Albert — 1.33.2
- Schopper, Jacob — 18.8.3, 18.13
- Schröter, Leonhard — 4.9.2
- Schulenburg, Joachim von der — 1.8.5
- Schwarz, Diebold — 1.30.1, 2.9.4, 2.13.2, 2.15.2, 4.11, 4.12, 4.A.5, 4.A.16, 5.6.1, 5.8, 5.9, 7.1.1, 7.5, 7.5.1, 7.5.2, 7.6
- Schwenckfeld, Caspar — 18.7.3
- Seiler, Georg — 18.7.1
- Sella, Joachim — 11.4.3
- Selnecker, Nikolaus — Introduction, 8.A.1, 8.A.2, 8.A.4
- Senfl, Ludwig — 4.1, 4.4.5, 4.10.4, 4.11
- Serinus — 1.31.8
- Sigismund, Archbishop of Magdeburg — 1.7.12, 6.6

- Sigismund II Augustus, King of Poland — 17.7.3
- Simon VI, Count of Lippe — 1.32.6
- Spangenberg, Cyriacus — 2.15.3
- Spangenberg, Johann — 4.10.1, 8.1.1, 8.1.3, 8.6, 8.6.4.3, 8.6.4.4, 8.16.8, 8.18.6, 8.19, 8.A.1, 10.1, 10.2, 10.9.6, 10.11.2, 10.11.4, 10.13, 11.4.6, 11.8.2, 11.13
- Spengler, Lazarus — 8.18.5
- Speratus, Paul — 8.11.2, 8.16.6, 8.18.5
- Stancarus, Francesco — 17.14.1
- Staphylus, Friedrich — 18.11.2
- Stieber, Thomas — 5.9, 10.14, 11.8.2, 11.14, 13.8.2, 13.20.1, 13.20.5, 13.22.5, 13.25, 14.4.5, 14.9, 14.10, 16.11, 18.4.1, 18.5.3, 18.8.3, 18.13, 18.14
- Stiphelius, Laurentius — 8.A.1
- Streitberger, Johann — 9.5.4
- Sulzer, Simon — 1.31.8

T

- Tertullian — 6.11, 16.9.2
- Triller, Valentin — 8.9.1, 8.19
- Truchsess von Waldburg, Gebhard, Archbishop of Cologne — 1.33.1

U

- Ulrich, Duke of Württemberg — 17.13.1
- Ursinus, Zacharias — 16.1, 16.6.3, 18.1.1, 18.5.4, 18.12, 18.13

V

- Vaet, Jacobus — 4.9.2, 4.10.4
- Varrelmann, Johannes — 1.15.3
- Veesenbeck, Johannes — 1.26.2
- Verbeke, Renatus — 16.5.2
- Victoria, Tomás Luis de — 4.1, 4.9.2, 4.10.4, 4.11, 8.12.2
- Virgil — 12.3.4
- Vögelin, Ernst — 17.3.3
- Volprecht, Wolfgang — 1.19.1, 2.4.8, 2.9.4, 2.10.3, 2.13.1, 2.13.2, 2.16, 3.1, 3.3.1, 3.3.2, 3.3.5, 3.4.1, 3.4.3, 3.4.4, 3.5.2, 3.5.4, 3.7, 3.8, 4.1, 4.2, 4.7.1, 4.8.1, 4.9.1, 4.11, 4.12, 4.A, 4.A.16, 5.1, 5.4.1, 5.5.1, 5.6.1, 5.6.2, 5.7, 5.8, 5.9, 5.A, Chapter 7, 7.1.1, 7.1.2, 7.3.2, 7.3.5, 7.7, 7.7.2, 7.8.4, 7.8.8, 7.10, 13.8.1

W

- Waldeck, Franz von, Bishop of Münster — 1.3.6, 1.33.6
- Walter, Johann — 4.1, 4.10.4
- Wert, Giaches de — 8.16.9
- Whittingham, William — 1.3.4
- Widensee, Eberhard — 1.15.2, 10.4.2, 10.8.1
- Wied, Hermann von, Archbishop of Cologne — Conventions, Chapter 1, 1.1, 1.2.5, 1.3.3, 1.33.1
- Wilhelm IV, Count of Henneberg — 1.7.9
- Wilhelm IV, Landgrave of Hesse-Kassel — 1.16.2
- Wilhelm the Younger, Duke of Brunswick-Lüneburg — 1.11.3, 10.8.3, 10.14, 16.7.5, 16.11
- Winkel, Heinrich — 7.15.2
- Wolfgang, Count of Hohenlohe — 10.14, 17.13.3
- Wolfgang, Count Palatine of Zweibrücken — 6.5, 6.6, 17.12.3
- Wolfgang, Duke of Brunswick-Grubenhagen — 1.12.5
- Wolfgang, Prince of Anhalt — 1.7.13, 17.6.6
- Wolfgang Ernst, Count of Ysenburg-Birstein — 6.18

Z

- Zanchi, Girolamo — 16.1, 16.6.3
- Zindel, Christian — 1.17.1
- Zuleger, Wenzel — 1.22.1, 15.2.1, 15.7.5, 15.13
- Zwick, Johannes — 1.3.3, 1.25.3
- Zwingli, Huldrych — 17.7.3

Glossary

This glossary explains the rarer terms of liturgy, church order and church life that the book uses, in English, German and Latin. Where the book treats a term at length, the entry ends with a link to that section. The usual English renderings of the orders' German terms are listed under Translations in the Conventions, and the traditions and the abbreviations under Traditions and the Interim and Abbreviations. They are not repeated here.

A · B · C · D · E · F · G · H · I · K · L · M · N · O · P · Q · R · S · T · U · V · W

A

- **accessus** (Latin). The priest's private preparation for Mass, an office of psalms and prayers said before he went to the altar. Several orders recast it as the congregation's *Veni Sancte Spiritus* before the introit. See §3.3.1, §3.3.7.
- **acolyte**. The highest of the four minor orders, who carried the candles and served the wine and water at the altar. Only the Bohemian Brethren kept acolytes. See §16.3.4, and *minor orders*.
- **acted ceremonies**. The dramatic ceremonies of the medieval year: the Palm Sunday ass (*Palmesel*), the Good Friday grave, the Easter image, the Ascension figure, the Whitsun dove and the rocking of the Christmas cradle (*Kindelwiegen*). The orders abolished them. See §12.10.10.
- **adiaphora** (Greek). "Things indifferent": ceremonies neither commanded nor forbidden by God, which a church may keep or drop for good order. The orders treat vestments, images and many ceremonies as such. See §14.3.
- **Adiutorium** (Latin). The versicle *Adiutorium nostrum in nomine Domini*, "Our help is in the name of the Lord", which opened the priest's preparation and many offices. It is the one opening versicle that survives widely in the evangelical orders. See §3.3.1.
- **Agende** (German; also *Agenda*, *Agendbüchlein*). The service book of a church: the forms for the Mass, baptism, marriage, burial and the other rites, printed with the church order or apart from it. See §1.2.4.
- **alb** (Latin *alba*). The long white linen tunic worn under the other vestments. See §14.7.1.
- **alternatim** (Latin). Performance in alternation: the organ takes a verse or stanza in turn with the choir or the people, and the verse it takes is played, not sung. See §9.3.3.
- **amice** (Latin *amictus*). The linen cloth put on round the neck before the alb.
- **Amt** (German). (1) The service, above all the communion service (*das Amt*, *Hochamt*). (2) A district of a territory under the prince's officer, the *Amtmann*, as "Amt Wittenberg".
- **Anabaptists**. The radical movement that rejected infant baptism and baptized believers. The orders proceed against it, save the Münster council's mandate of 1534, which tolerated it. See §1.3.6.
- **angelicum** (Latin). See *Kyrie chants*.
- **antiphon**. A short sung text, usually from Scripture, sung before and after a psalm or canticle in the office, or on its own.
- **antiphoner**. The choir book of the chants of the office: antiphons, responsories and hymns. The Lutheran antiphoners of Spangenberg (1545) and Lossius (1553) purged and reprinted the old chant. See §10.11.2.
- **Auctuarium** (Latin). The *Mehrung der vorigen Kirchenordnung* of Brandenburg-Ansbach (1548), the adaptation of its church order to the Interim, and one of the Interim orders in the set. See §1.4.
- **Aufer a nobis** (Latin). "Take away from us [our iniquities]": the prayer the priest said as he went up to the altar after the *Confiteor*. It survives in German in Müntzer's Allstedt Mass, and in Latin after the sermon in the *Cellische Ordnungen* of 1545. See §3.3.1, §3.3.8.
- **Auslaufen** (German, "running out"). Going across a border to the worship of another confession, for its sermons and sacraments. Every confession forbade its people to do it. See §18.5.4.

B

- **ban** (German *Bann*). Church discipline by exclusion: the lesser ban kept a sinner from the Lord's Supper, the greater ban (*excommunicatio maior*) from the fellowship of the church. See §13.16.1.
- **banns**. The public announcement of an intended marriage in church, so that any impediment might be declared. See §13.7.5.
- **Begängnis** (German). A memorial service for the dead on the seventh or thirtieth day or the anniversary, abolished with the soul-Masses. See §10.9, §13.9.1.
- **Beichtgeld** (German). Confession-money: the offering given to the confessor at private confession. See §13.17.4.

- **Benedicamus** (Latin). The versicle *Benedicamus Domino*, "Let us bless the Lord", answered *Deo gratias*, which closes the office and, on days without a Gloria, the Mass. The orders kept it, sang it to melodies graded by feast, and put it into German. See §2.13.1, §8.16.8.
- **Benedictus** (Latin). (1) The Song of Zechariah, the canticle of Lauds. (2) *Benedictus qui venit*, "Blessed is he that cometh", which follows the Sanctus. See §2.10.3, §8.4.3.
- **benefice**. A church office with an endowed income, such as a canonry, a vicarage or an altar, held on condition of saying Mass or the hours. See §10.6.2.
- **Bestallung** (German). A letter of appointment for a church officer, such as a preacher, schoolmaster, organist or bell-ringer, setting out his duties and wages. He answered it with a *Revers*. See §13.12.2.
- **betrothal** (German *Verlöbnis*, *Eheversprechen*). The binding promise of marriage, given before witnesses. Only the consistory or the marriage court could release it. See §13.7.8, §13.7.9.
- **Bittherren** (German). The twelve lay collectors (*subdiaconi*) of St Wenzel's at Naumburg, chosen from the council and the community, who stood at the church doors with collecting boards. See §16.5.2.
- **Brautpredigt** (German; also *Hochzeitpredigt*). The wedding sermon. See §11.4.7.

C

- **Candlemas**. The feast of the Purification of Mary, 2 February, with the blessing of candles. See §12.8.1.
- **Canon** (Latin). The fixed prayer of the Roman Mass between the Sanctus and the Lord's Prayer, said quietly by the priest, with the Words of Institution at its centre. Its prayers are named by their first words, from *Te igitur* to the closing doxology *Per ipsum*. The evangelical orders dropped it or kept only fragments. See Chapter 7.
- **canon minor** (Latin). "The lesser canon": the offertory prayers, as distinct from the Canon proper, the *canon maior*. The evangelical orders dropped both. See §4.7.1.
- **canonical hours**. The daily round of offices of the medieval church: Matins, Lauds, Prime, Terce, Sext, None, Vespers and Compline. See §10.5.1.
- **canticle**. A song of Scripture other than a psalm, sung in the office: the *Benedictus* at Lauds, the *Magnificat* at Vespers, the *Nunc dimittis* at Compline, and the Old Testament canticles such as the *Benedicite*.
- **cantional**. A school and choir book of the Latin and German chants of the year. Several orders required the cantionals of Spangenberg and Lossius. See §8.18.6.
- **cantor**. The master of the choir, usually a schoolmaster, who led the singing of the scholars at Mass and office. See §13.12.3.
- **cantrix** (Latin; Low German *sengersche*, German *Vorsängerin*). The precentress of a women's convent, who began the antiphons and psalms and ordered the singing of the choir. See §16.9.6.
- **ceroferarius** (Latin; also *accensor*). The candle-bearer, who carried a candle at the gospel and in processions. See §16.4.4.
- **charmer** (German *Segner*, *Segensprecher*). One who healed or protected people, cattle and goods with blessings, spoken or written (*Segen*). The orders count charmers among the sorcerers, and bar both them and those who seek them out from the Supper. See §13.20.
- **chasuble** (German *Meßgewand*, *Casel*). The priest's outer vestment at Mass, a wide mantle without sleeves. Many Lutheran orders kept it; the Reformed abolished it. See §14.7.1.
- **choraliter** (Latin). Sung in plainsong, as against *figuraliter*, in figured music. See §4.10.4.
- **chrism**. The consecrated mixture of olive oil and balsam used at baptism, confirmation and ordination. The plainer *oil of catechumens* was used before baptism. Only two evangelical orders kept the chrism. See §13.15.4.
- **churching** (German *Kirchgang*, *Aussegnung*). A mother's return to church after childbirth, at the end of her six weeks. In the orders it is a thanksgiving, not a purification. See §13.5.
- **ciborium**. A covered vessel for the consecrated hosts kept in reserve. See §14.6.7.
- **collect** (Latin *collecta*). The short prayer of the day, said by the priest before the epistle after "Let us pray". See Chapter 5.
- **collegiate church**. A church served by a chapter of canons, who sang the hours in choir. See §10.4.2.
- **commixture**. The dropping of a particle of the host into the chalice after the fraction, with the prayer *Haec commixtio*. See §7.6.11.
- **commune sanctorum** (Latin). "The common of saints": the propers shared by all the saints of one kind, such as apostles, martyrs or virgins, used where a saint had none of his own. See §12.4.4.
- **Communicantes** (Latin). The prayer of the Canon that joins the Church's offering to the memory of the Virgin, the apostles and the martyrs. See §7.6.4, and *Canon*.
- **communio** (Latin). The communion chant: an antiphon sung during or after the distribution. See §4.9.

- **complenda** (Latin). The old name of the prayer after communion, the postcommunion. Several orders still gave it to Luther's thanksgiving. See §5.6.3.
- **Compline** (Latin *completorium*, German *Complet*). The last office of the day, said before sleep. See Chapter 10.
- **confirmation** (German *Firmung*). In the medieval church a sacrament given by the bishop with chrism; in the evangelical orders an examination in the catechism, with profession, prayer and the laying on of hands, before first communion. See §13.6.
- **Confiteor** (Latin). "I confess to Almighty God": the confession of sins said by the priest and his ministers at the foot of the altar, answered by the *Misereatur* and the *Indulgentiam*. See §3.3.2.
- **confraternity** (German *Bruderschaft*). A brotherhood of lay people for devotion, Masses for the dead and the keeping of an altar. The orders dissolved them into the common chest. See §16.7.6.
- **Consensus of Sandomierz** (Latin *Consensus Sendomiriensis*). The union of 1570 in which the Lutheran, Reformed and Bohemian Brethren churches of Poland owned one another's doctrine as orthodox and opened their pulpits and altars to one another. See §18.11.3.
- **consistory** (German *Konsistorium*). The territorial church court and board of theologians and jurists, which examined ministers, judged marriage cases and kept discipline. See §15.5.
- **convent**. (1) A religious house of monks or nuns. (2) A meeting of the clergy of a district for study and mutual correction. See §10.4.4, §15.7.5.
- **cope** (German *Chorkappe*, *Chormantel*). A long cloak open at the front, worn in processions, at the office and at services without communion. See §14.7.2.
- **corporal**. The square linen cloth spread on the altar under the chalice and the host. See §14.6.2.
- **Corpus Christi**. The feast of the Body of Christ on the Thursday after Trinity Sunday, with its procession of the sacrament. Most evangelical orders abolished it. See §12.8.9.
- **corpus doctrinae** (Latin). "A body of doctrine": the collection of confessions that a church declared to be its standard of teaching, as the *Corpus doctrinae Philippicum* (1560). See §17.3.
- **Corpus tuum** (Latin). The priest's prayer after communion, "Thy body, O Lord, which I have received", which Luther kept as a postcommunion in 1523. See §5.6.1.

D

- **dalmatic**, **tunicle**. The outer vestments of the deacon and subdeacon at a solemn Mass. See §14.2.3.
- **de tempore** (Latin). "Of the season": the propers, lessons and hymns of the Sundays and feasts of the church year, as against those *de sanctis*, of the saints' days. See §12.4.4.
- **deacons of the poor** (Latin *diaconi pauperum*). Laymen chosen to collect and give out the alms. In the Lutheran orders they were often the managers of the common chest. See §16.5.2.
- **dean** (Latin *decanus*). A minister set over the pastors of a district under the superintendent; in Transylvania the head of a chapter. See §15.4.
- **Deutsche Messe** (German). Luther's German Mass of 1526, written for the parishes, and with the *Formula missae* one of the two baselines of the evangelical Mass. See §2.3.3.
- **devil-conjurer** (German *Teufelsbeschwerer*). One who claimed to command the devil by conjuration, to cast him out or to learn hidden things through him. The orders forbid them with the sorcerers. See §13.8.7, §13.20.3.
- **Diaconus** (Latin; German *Helfer*, *Kaplan*, *Capellan*). In the Lutheran orders the assistant minister of a parish, an ordained preacher under the pastor, not the deacon of the medieval Mass. See §16.5.1.
- **dominicale** (Latin). See *Kyrie chants*.
- **Dominus vobiscum** (Latin). "The Lord be with you", the priest's salutation, answered *Et cum spiritu tuo*, "And with thy spirit", before the collect, the Preface and the blessing. See §2.8.
- **duplex**, **semiduplex**, **simplex** (Latin). Grades of feast in the medieval calendar, with *totum duplex* and *summum* above them, which decided how the office and Mass of the day were kept. The evangelical orders do not use them. See §12.4.1.

E

- **early sermon** (German *Frühpredigt*). The first sermon of a Sunday or feast, preached early in the morning before the Mass.
- **Easter sepulchre**. The "Good Friday grave", in which the host or the crucifix was laid from Good Friday until Easter morning. The orders abolished it. See §13.22.4, and *acted ceremonies*.
- **elevation**. The lifting up of the consecrated host and chalice after the Words of Institution, for the people to see. Many Lutheran orders kept it for a time, often with a bell or a hymn. See §2.11, §8.12.3.

- **Ember days** (German *Quatember*, *Fronfasten*). The fast days of the four seasons: the Wednesday, Friday and Saturday after the first Sunday in Lent, after Whitsunday, after Holy Cross Day and after St Lucy's Day. The orders keep them not as fasts but as the four quarter days of the church year, for payments and for preaching the catechism. See §12.12.7.
- **embolism**. The prayer *Libera nos* ("Deliver us, we beseech thee, O Lord"), which takes up the last petition of the Lord's Prayer in the Mass. See §7.6.10.
- **emergency baptism** (German *Nottaufe*, *Jähtaufe*). Baptism given at home by the midwife or another lay person when a newborn child was in danger of death. See §13.3.7.
- **Et in terra** (Latin). The Gloria in excelsis from its second clause, "And on earth peace", which the choir takes up after the priest has intoned *Gloria in excelsis Deo*. See §2.7.2.
- **examen** (Latin; German *Verhör*). An examination: of candidates before ordination, of children in the catechism, of communicants before the Supper. See §15.7.3, §13.17.4.
- **exhortation** (German *Vermahnung*). A set address to the people, above all the exhortation to the communicants before the Supper. See §3.5.
- **exorcism**. The command to the devil at baptism to come out of the child, as in Luther's "Fahr aus, du unreiner Geist". It was kept and defended, and later in the century disputed and in places dropped. The exorcisms of salt, water, oil and chrism were abolished as godless. See §13.4, §13.20.1.
- **extreme unction**. The anointing of the dying with oil. No evangelical order prescribes it: the Word, the absolution, the Supper and prayer take its place. See §13.8.1.

F

- **farsed** (also *farced* or *troped*). Of a chant: interlaced with added words. A farsed Kyrie or sequence alternates its Latin with Latin verses or German stanzas. See §8.6.4, §8.8.3.
- **Fastnacht** (German). Shrovetide, the carnival before Lent, with its mumming and dancing, which the orders forbade as heathen. See §12.11.4.
- **festive**, **ferialiter**, **dominicaliter**, **solenniter** (Latin). "In festal, weekday, Sunday or solemn manner": rubrics for the grade of chant and ceremony on a given day. See §12.4.5.
- **festum fori**, **festum chori** (Latin). A feast "of the court", on which work was forbidden, and a feast "of the choir", kept only in the liturgy. See §12.4.
- **figured music** (Latin *figuraliter*, *in mensuris*; German *figurieren*). Polyphony written in measured notes, as against plainsong. See §10.11.4, §12.10.5.
- **Flectamus genua** (Latin). "Let us bend the knee", the bidding before each of the Good Friday solemn prayers, answered *Levate*, "Arise". See §13.21.6.
- **formata** (Latin, *litterae formatae*). The letters by which a bishop attested a cleric's ordination. See §18.7.2.
- **Formula missae** (Latin). Luther's Latin order of the Mass of 1523, the *Formula missae et communionis*, and with the *Deutsche Messe* one of the two baselines of the evangelical Mass. See §2.3.2.
- **fraction**. The breaking of the host before communion. See §7.6.11.

G

- **Generalartikel** (German). General articles: the instructions of a visitation that applied to every parish of a territory.
- **German psalm** (German *deutscher Psalm*). Any German hymn sung by the people, not only a psalm paraphrase. See §8.5.1.
- **Gnesio-Lutherans** (Greek *gnesios*, "genuine"). The strict Lutheran party, led by Flacius, that resisted the Interim and the Philippists; also called Flacians. See §17.1.1.
- **godparents** (German *Gevatter*, *Paten*). The sponsors at baptism, who answer for the child and promise to see it taught. See §13.3.8, §17.17.4, §18.4.3.
- **Gottesacker** (German). "God's acre": the burial ground, often outside the town. See §13.9.4.
- **gradual**. (1) The chant after the epistle, taken from a psalm. (2) The choir book of the chants of the Mass. See §4.6.

H

- **Hagelfeier** (German). A holy day of processions against hail, forbidden by the orders. See §12.11.4.
- **Hanc igitur** (Latin). The prayer of the Canon that offers "this oblation of our service". See §7.6.5, and *Canon*.
- **Handschlag** (German; Latin *stipulata manu*). The handclasp by which a promise was given, in betrothal and in the pledges of ministers and church officers. See §13.7.8.

- **Hauptlied** (German). "Chief hymn": the hymn of the day for a Sunday or feast. The word is later and does not occur in the corpus. See §8.A.
- **Heiligenpfleger** (German). In Swabia and Franconia, the lay churchwardens who kept the goods of the parish church (the "saint's" goods). See §16.9.7.
- **Hochzeit** (German). A wedding. In older use also a high feast, as in "the four *Hochzeiten*" (see *Vierzeiten*).

I

- **Indulgentiam** (Latin). The absolution after the *Confiteor* and *Misereatur*: "May the almighty and merciful Lord grant us pardon, absolution and remission of our sins". See §3.4.3.
- **infulae** (Latin). Properly the mitre and its bands. In the Transylvanian synods the word most likely means the chasubles. See §14.7.3.
- **inspector**. An overseer of the pastors of a district, a name used in some territories beside or for the superintendent. See §15.4.1.
- **Interim**. The Augsburg Interim of 1548, the emperor's provisional settlement of religion until a council, which allowed the Protestants only the cup and married priests; and the Leipzig Interim (1548/49), Electoral Saxony's milder version. See §1.4.
- **Introibo** (Latin). "I will go unto the altar of God" (Ps 43:4), the antiphon of the priest's preparation, said with Psalm 43, *Iudica me*. See §3.3.1.
- **introit**. The entrance chant of the Mass: an antiphon with a psalm verse and the *Gloria Patri*. Its first words name the Sunday in many cases. See §4.4.
- **investiture** (German *Investitur*). The installation of a pastor in his parish by the superintendent, a rite apart from ordination. See §13.11.
- **invitatory**. Psalm 95, *Venite*, sung with an antiphon at the beginning of Matins. See §10.5.2.
- **Ite, missa est** (Latin). "Go, it is the dismissal": the deacon's dismissal at the end of Mass on days with a Gloria. See §2.13.1.
- **Iudica me** (Latin). Psalm 43, "Judge me, O God", said by the priest at the foot of the altar. It survives in the evangelical orders as the introit of Judica Sunday. See §3.3.8.

K

- **Kaland** (German, plural *Kalande*). A brotherhood of clergy and lay people that met on the first day of the month, the Kalends, for Masses for the dead and a common meal. See §16.7.6.
- **Kastenherren** (German). The managers of the common chest (*gemeiner Kasten*), the fund that took over the church's endowments for the ministers, the schools and the poor. See §16.5.2.
- **Kinderlehre** (German). The catechism class for children on Sunday afternoons, held by question and answer. See §11.4.3, §10.10.
- **Kirchenordnung** (German). A church order: the law that a prince or a city council gave its church. It says who shall preach and what, how the sacraments and the services are to be held, and how ministers, schools and discipline are to be ordered. See §1.2.1.
- **Kirchenrat** (German). A church council: a board of theologians and councillors that governed the church under the prince, as in Württemberg and the Palatinate. See §15.5.
- **Kirchgang** (German). "Going to church": the churching of a mother; the bridal party's procession to church; or church attendance in general. See §13.5.2.
- **Kirchweih** (German; also *Kirmes*, *Kirchmesse*). The anniversary of a church's dedication, and the fair and festivities that went with it. See §13.14.4.
- **Kyrie chants**. The named plainsong settings of the Kyrie, each assigned to a season or a rank of feast: the *dominicale*, *paschale*, *angelicum*, *summum*, *minus summum*, *apostolicum*, *Fons bonitatis*, *Magne Deus*, *de martyribus* and *de virginibus*. The orders with Latin schools kept them by name. See §2.6.2, §12.4.2.

L

- **Lauds**. The morning office of praise, sung after Matins, with the canticle *Benedictus*. See Chapter 10.
- **Lavabo** (Latin). The washing of the priest's hands at the offertory, with Psalm 26:6, "I will wash my hands in innocency". See §2.1.
- **lectio continua** (Latin). Reading a book of Scripture straight through, chapter after chapter, instead of the passages appointed for each Sunday. See §4.5.2.
- **Leichpredigt** (German). The funeral sermon. See §11.4.6.

- **Leise** (German; plural *Leisen*). A medieval German hymn of the people whose stanzas end *Kyrieleis*, such as "Christ ist erstanden", sung at the high feasts. See §8.10.2.
- **Lenten veil** (German *Hungertuch*). The cloth hung before the altar or the choir through Lent. See §14.1.
- **levites** (German *Leviten*). In the south German imperial cities, the two assistants at the altar, the gospeller and the epistoler, named after the ministers of the Old Testament. Outside the cathedrals they were in practice priests. See §16.4.3.
- **litany**. A long prayer of petitions, sung by two voices or choirs answering one another. In the orders it is usually Luther's German or Latin litany of 1529, sung on weekdays, on prayer days and in time of war or plague. See §10.7.5, §13.21.
- **little hours**. Prime, Terce, Sext and None, the short offices of the first, third, sixth and ninth hours of the day. See §10.4.2.
- **Loci** (Latin). Melanchthon's *Loci communes*, first published in 1521 and much revised, the handbook of Lutheran doctrine, named in many orders as a standard of teaching. See §17.5.1.

M

- **mandatum de non calumniando** (Latin). "Mandate against calumny": an order forbidding the preachers of one confession to revile the other, as in the Reformed Upper Palatinate in 1598. See §18.8.3.
- **maniple**. A strip of cloth worn over the left forearm by the priest at Mass. See §14.2.3.
- **marriage court** (German *Ehegericht*). The court that judged betrothal, marriage and divorce cases; in many territories the consistory. See §13.7.9.
- **Matins** (German *Mette*). The night office of psalms, lessons and responsories. In the evangelical orders it was mostly a school office early in the morning. See §10.5.2.
- **Memento** (Latin). The prayers of the Canon for the living and for the dead, "Remember, O Lord". See §7.6.4, and *Canon*.
- **minor orders**. The four lower grades of the clergy below the subdiaconate: porter, lector, exorcist and acolyte. The evangelical orders did not confer them. See §16.3.
- **Misereatur** (Latin). "May almighty God have mercy upon thee": the prayer for forgiveness that answers the *Confiteor*. See §3.4.3.
- **monstrance**. A vessel with a glass case in which the consecrated host was shown for adoration and carried in procession. See §13.18.4.
- **motet**. A polyphonic setting of a Latin or German text, sung by the choir on feasts. See §4.9.2.

N

- **Nobis quoque** (Latin). "To us sinners also": the prayer of the Canon after the memento of the dead, asking a share with the saints. See *Canon*.
- **norma doctrinae** (Latin). "A norm of doctrine": the confession or list of books by which a church's teaching was to be judged. See §17.14.2.
- **notel** (Low German). A written form or statement. (1) The Lower Saxon exhortation to prayer read "from the notel" after the sermon (see §6.14). (2) Danzig's confessional statement of 1562 (see §17.7.3).
- **Nunc dimittis** (Latin). The Song of Simeon, "Lord, now lettest thou thy servant depart in peace", sung at Compline and in some orders after communion. See §2.13.2.

O

- **octave**. The eighth day after a great feast, or the whole week to that day, kept with the feast's propers. See §12.4.4.
- **Offene Schuld** (German). "The open guilt": the general confession and absolution of the medieval preaching service, said after the sermon. Several orders moved it into the Mass. See §3.3.5.
- **offertory**. The chant and prayers at the preparation of the bread and wine. To Luther they "smelled of oblation", and most orders dropped them. See §4.7.
- **Office of the Dead** (Latin *officium defunctorum*; German *Vigilie*). The office for the departed, sung beside the hours of the day: Vespers (*Placebo*), Matins (*Dirige*) with nine lessons from Job, and Lauds. It was sung on the evening or in the night before a requiem Mass, at the burial, on the third, seventh and thirtieth days and at the anniversary. The orders call it the vigil, and abolished it. See §10.9.
- **Orate fratres** (Latin). "Pray, brethren": the priest's request for the people's prayers at the offertory. See §7.6.1.
- **Ordnung** (German). An order, the general word for the documents in the set: *Kirchenordnung* (church order), *Gottesdienstordnung* (order of service), *Visitationsordnung* (visitation order), *Konsistorialordnung* (consistory order), *Kirchenzuchtordnung* (order of church discipline), *Schulordnung* (school order). See §1.2.4.

P

- **pall**. A stiffened square of linen laid over the chalice. See §14.6.2.
- **paraments**. The cloths and hangings of a church: the covers of the altar, the pulpit and the font. See §14.6.
- **paschale** (Latin). See *Kyrie chants*.
- **paten**. The small plate for the host at Mass. See §14.6.7.
- **Patrem** (Latin). The Nicene Creed, named from the words the choir takes up after the priest's intonation *Credo in unum Deum*: *Patrem omnipotentem*. See §2.9.
- **Pax** (Latin). The peace: the greeting *Pax Domini sit semper vobiscum*, "The peace of the Lord be always with you", before the Agnus Dei, and the kiss of peace that went with it. Luther called the greeting "a kind of public absolution". See §2.8, §2.15.9.
- **Per ipsum** (Latin). "By him, and with him, and in him": the doxology that ends the Canon. See *Canon*.
- **pericope**. A passage of Scripture appointed to be read on a given Sunday or feast: the epistle or gospel of the day. See §4.5.
- **Placeat** (Latin). The priest's prayer to the Trinity before the blessing at the end of Mass, *Placeat tibi, sancta Trinitas*. See §7.2.7.
- **plainsong**. The unaccompanied, single-line chant of the Latin liturgy. See §4.10.
- **police order** (German *Polizeiordnung*). An order of public discipline, for dress, feasting, weddings, swearing and Sunday rest. "Police" has its old sense, the good order of a community. See §1.2.4.
- **poltergeist** (German *Poltergeist*, Low German *poltergeyst*, "rumbling ghost"). A ghost thought to haunt a house with noise and to appear asking for Masses. Bugenhagen's orders hold such ghosts to be devils. See §13.20.2.
- **postcommunion**. The collect after communion. In the Lutheran orders it was usually Luther's thanksgiving of 1526. See §5.6.
- **postil** (German *Postille*). A book of sermons on the Sunday gospels and epistles, from which pastors preached or read, such as Luther's *Hauspostille*. See §11.8.
- **prayer bell** (German *Betglocke*). The bell rung morning, noon and evening for prayer, which the orders turned into a bell *pro pace*, for peace, for the government and against the Turk. See §9.5.3.
- **prayer day** (German *Bettag*). A day of prayer and repentance appointed by the authorities, weekly, monthly or in time of war, plague and the Turkish threat, with a sermon of repentance at its centre. See §11.4.5.
- **preces** (Latin). A series of short versicles and responses, with the Kyrie and the Lord's Prayer, said at the end of an office. See §10.7.5.
- **Preface**. The thanksgiving that opens the eucharistic prayer, after the dialogue *Sursum corda*, and leads into the Sanctus. The *Proper Prefaces* vary it for the seasons and feasts. See §2.10, §4.8.
- **presbyterae** (Latin). The women elders of the Bohemian Brethren, elected by the women. See §16.6.4, §16.9.3.
- **private confession** (German *Beicht*, *Ohrenbeicht*). Confession of sins to the pastor alone, with his absolution, before communion. See §13.17.
- **Probepredigt** (German). The trial sermon a candidate preached before his examination or appointment. See §11.11.2.
- **prophecy** (German *Prophezei*). In Micron's Dutch church in London, the weekly meeting at which chosen men of the congregation questioned the ministers on the week's preaching, or expounded a book of Scripture in turn. See §16.9.8.
- **public penance** (German *Kirchenbuße*). Penance done before the congregation for an open sin, ending in public reconciliation. See §13.16.
- **pyx**. A small box for the host, above all for carrying the sacrament to the sick. See §14.6.7.

Q

- **Quam oblationem** (Latin). The prayer of the Canon before the Words of Institution, asking that the offering be made "the Body and Blood" of Christ. See §7.6.6, and *Canon*.
- **Qui pridie** (Latin). "Who the day before he suffered": the Canon's account of the institution. See §7.6.7.
- **Quod ore sumpsimus** (Latin). "What we have taken with our mouth": a postcommunion prayer, which Luther kept in 1523. See §5.6.1.

R

- **recess** (German *Abschied*). The written decisions issued at the end of a visitation, a synod or a diet.
- **reconciliation of a church** (Latin *reconciliatio*). The rite by which a profaned church or churchyard was purified before it could be used again. No evangelical order has it. See §13.20.

- **Repetitio** (Latin). The *Confessio Saxonica* of 1551, Melanchthon's restatement of the Augsburg Confession for the Council of Trent, part of the *Corpus doctrinae Philippicum*. Naming it marks an order as Philippist or Reformed. See §17.3.3.
- **responsory**. A chant of response and verse, with the response repeated, sung after a lesson at Matins and elsewhere.
- **Revers** (German). A signed undertaking by which a minister or church officer bound himself to his duties or his confession on taking office. See §17.4.
- **Rogation days** (German *Bittwoche*, *Kreuzwoche*). The three days before Ascension Day, with processions through the fields to pray for the harvest. See §12.12.5.

S

- **sacrament house** (German *Sakramentshäuslein*). A tall stone shrine in the chancel in which the consecrated host was reserved. See §14.5.5.
- **Sacramentarians**. In the Lutheran polemic, those who denied the bodily presence of Christ in the Supper: the Zwinglians and, later, the Calvinists. See Chapter 18.
- **Salve Regina** (Latin). "Hail, Queen": the antiphon to the Virgin sung in the evening after Compline. The orders abolished it or turned it to Christ. See §8.16.5.
- **Sanctus bell**. A small bell rung at the Sanctus and at the elevation. See §9.5.4.
- **Schwenckfelders**. The followers of Caspar Schwenckfeld, a Silesian spiritualist who set the inner word above the outward word and sacraments. See §1.3.6.
- **screen** (German *Lettner*, *Schranken*, *Gitter*). The partition, rail or grille that divided the choir from the nave. See §14.5.7.
- **secret** (Latin *secreta*). The prayer said quietly over the gifts at the end of the offertory, abolished with it. See §5.5.
- **Seelfrau** (German, plural *Seelfrauen*). A woman appointed by the town council to nurse the sick and to attend and comfort the dying. See §16.7.3.
- **Segen** (German). (1) A blessing, as the Aaronic blessing. (2) A charm: a formula, spoken or written, to heal or protect, as the charmers (*Segner*) used it. See §13.20.3.
- **seniores** (Latin; German *Eltesten*). Elders: laymen chosen to keep church discipline with the ministers. In the Reformed orders they governed the church with them. See §16.6.
- **Septuagesima** (Latin). The ninth Sunday before Easter, with Sexagesima and Quinquagesima (*Estomihi*) after it: the pre-Lenten season. See §13.23.7.
- **sequence**. A rhymed chant sung after the alleluia on feasts, such as *Victimae paschali* at Easter. The orders cut the sequences back to the chief feasts, or farsed them with German stanzas. See §4.6.4, §8.8.3.
- **Stipendium** (Latin). A foundation that maintained poor students of theology, as the ducal *Stipendium* at Tübingen. See §15.7.2.
- **stole**. A long narrow band of cloth worn round the neck by priests and deacons. See §14.7.3.
- **Stufengebet** (German). "The prayer at the steps": the priest's preparation at the foot of the altar, with *Introibo*, Psalm 43 and the *Confiteor*. See §3.3.1.
- **subdeacon** (Latin *subdiaconus*). The cleric of the lowest major order, who sang the epistle at a solemn Mass. The evangelical orders did not confer the order. See §16.3.
- **suffrages**. Short petitions with their responses, said at the end of an office or in the litany. See §10.7.5.
- **summa festa** (Latin). The highest feasts. See §12.4.2.
- **summum** (Latin). The highest grade of chant and feast, with *minus summum* below it. See §12.4.2, and *Kyrie chants*.
- **Sunday names**. The Sundays of Lent and Eastertide are named by the opening words of their introit: *Invocavit*, *Reminiscere*, *Oculi*, *Laetare* and *Judica* in Lent; *Quasimodogeniti*, *Misericordias Domini*, *Jubilate*, *Cantate*, *Rogate* and *Exaudi* after Easter.
- **super populum** (Latin). The *oratio super populum*, "the prayer over the people", said after the postcommunion on the weekdays of Lent, with the bidding *Humiliate capita vestra Deo*, "Bow down your heads before God". See §5.6.6.
- **superintendent** (Latin *superattendens*). The minister who oversaw the pastors of a district or a whole territory, in place of a bishop. See §15.4.
- **Supplices** (Latin). The prayer of the Canon asking that the offering be carried by the angel to the altar on high. See §7.6.9, and *Canon*.
- **Supra quae** (Latin). The prayer of the Canon that asks God to look on the offering as on those of Abel, Abraham and Melchizedek. See §7.6.8.
- **surplice** (German *Chorrock*, *Chorhemd*; Latin *superpellicium*). A wide white linen garment with sleeves. In many Lutheran orders it was the minister's vestment. See §14.7.4.
- **Sursum corda** (Latin). "Lift up your hearts": the dialogue that opens the Preface. See §2.10.

T

- **Taufbüchlein** (German). Luther's "little book of baptism", the German order of baptism of 1523, revised in 1526. See §13.3.2, §13.3.3.
- **Te igitur** (Latin). "Thee therefore, most merciful Father": the first prayer of the Canon, which commends the Church, the pope and the bishop. See §7.6.3, and *Canon*.
- **Tenebrae** (Latin, "darkness"). The Matins and Lauds of the last three days of Holy Week, at which the candles were put out one by one. Some orders also name a Tenebrae ringing on Fridays for the Passion. See §9.5.3.
- **thurifer**. The server who carried the censer. See §16.4.4.
- **tract**. The chant sung in place of the alleluia from Septuagesima to Easter. See §4.6.

U

- **Ubiquitists**. The Reformed name for the Lutherans who taught that Christ's human nature is present everywhere, the "ubiquity" of his body. See §18.5.4.
- **Unde et memores** (Latin). The prayer of the Canon after the institution that remembers the Passion, Resurrection and Ascension and offers the sacrifice. See §7.6.8.

V

- **variata**, **invariata** (Latin). The altered edition of the Augsburg Confession that Melanchthon published in 1540 (*variata*), and the unaltered confession of 1530 (*invariata*). See §17.3.2.
- **Verba** (Latin). The Words of Institution of the Lord's Supper, "Our Lord Jesus Christ, the same night in which he was betrayed". See §2.11.
- **versicle**. A short verse said or sung by the minister and answered by the people or the choir. See §3.3.
- **Vierzeiten** (German; Low German *veer tide*). "The four times": in north Germany the four chief feasts, Christmas, Easter, Whitsuntide and Michaelmas (formerly the Assumption), on which the four-times penny was paid. See §12.9.
- **vigil**. (1) The day before a great feast, or the night office kept on it. See §12.4.6. (2) The office for the dead (*Vigilie*). See *Office of the Dead*.
- **visitation**. (1) The inspection of the parishes by commissioners of the prince or council, who examined pastors and people and set down their orders in a recess. (2) The feast of the Visitation of Mary, 2 July. See §1.2.4, §12.8.2.

W

- **weather-ringing** (German *Wetterläuten*). Ringing the bells against storms and hail, which many orders forbade as superstition. See §9.5.8, §13.15.5.
- **Westerhemd** (German). The white christening robe put on the child after baptism. See §13.3.3.